2024 ASHRAE© HANDBOOK

Heating, Ventilating, and Air-Conditioning SYSTEMS AND EQUIPMENT

SI Edition

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MTG.HCDG Hot Climate Design Guide
MTG.IAST Impact of ASHRAE Standards and Technology on Energy Savings/Performance
MTG.LowGWP Lower Global Warming Potential Alternative Refrigerants
MTG.OBB Occupant Behavior in Buildings
MTG.RAC Refrigeration and Air-Conditioning Plant Assessment Guide
MTG.RES Resilience
MTG.VIC Ventilation for Infection Control

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ASHRAE is the world's foremost technical society in the fields of heating, ventilation, air conditioning, and refrigeration. Its members worldwide are individuals who share ideas, identify needs, support research, and write the industry's standards for testing and practice. The result is that engineers are better able to keep indoor environments safe and productive while protecting and preserving the outdoors for generations to come.

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Heather "Molière" Kennedy
Editor, ASHRAE Handbook

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Heather "Molière" Kennedy
Editor, ASHRAE Handbook

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AN HVAC system maintains desired environmental conditions in a space. In almost every application, many options are available to the design engineer to satisfy a client's building program and design intent. In the analysis, selection, and implementation of these options, the design engineer should consider the criteria defined here, as well as project-specific parameters to achieve the functional requirements associated with the project design intent. In addition to the design, equipment, and system aspects of the proposed design, the design engineer should consider sustainability as it pertains to responsible energy and environmental design, as well as constructability of the design.

HVAC systems are categorized by the method used to produce, deliver, and control heating, ventilating, and air conditioning in the conditioned area. This chapter addresses procedures for selecting an appropriate system for a given application while taking into account pertinent issues associated with designing, building, commissioning, operating, and maintaining the system. It also addresses specific owner requirements and constraints associated with selecting the optimum HVAC system for the application. Chapters 2 to 18 describe specific approaches and systems along with their attributes, based on their heating and cooling medium, the commonly used variations, constructability, commissioning, operation, and maintenance.

This chapter is intended as a guide for the design engineer, builder, facility manager, and student needing to know or reference the analysis and selection process that ultimately leads to recommending the optimum system for the job. The approach applies to HVAC equipment conversions, building system upgrades, system retrofits, building renovations and expansion, and new construction for any building: small, medium, large, below grade, at grade, low-rise, and high-rise. This system analysis and selection process (Figure 1) approach helps guide the design engineer in drafting a report that recommends the best system(s) for any building program, regardless of facility type. This chapter's analysis examines objective, subjective, short-term, and long-term goals along with constraints. Figure 1 also highlights five project delivery methods: performance contracting, design-bid-build, design-build, integrated building design, and construction management.

1. SELECTING A SYSTEM

The design engineer is responsible for considering various systems and equipment and recommending one or more system options that will meet the project goals and perform per the design intent. It is imperative that the design engineer and owner collaborate to identify and prioritize criteria associated with the design goals. In addition, if the project includes preconstruction services, the designer, owner, and operator should consult with a builder to take advantage of a constructability analysis as well as the consideration of value-engineered options. Occupant comfort (as defined by ASHRAE *Standard* 55), process heating, space heating, cooling, and ventilation criteria must be considered when selecting the optimum system(s), as well as the following:

- Temperature
- Humidity
- Air motion
- Air/water velocity
- Water quality and/or reuse
- Outdoor air quality or purity
- Indoor air purity or quality
- Air changes per hour
- Acoustics and vibration
- Local climate
- Mold and mildew prevention
- Capacities (existing, proposed, and future expansion)
- Redundancy
- Spatial requirements (present and future)
- Environmental health and safety design
- Security
- First cost
- Return-on-investment cost
- Energy consumption costs
- Operator labor costs
- Maintenance costs
- Serviceability
- Reliability
- Flexibility
- Controllability
- Replaceability
- Life-cycle analysis
- Sustainability of design
- Seismic protection
- Filtration and filtration effects
- Changing codes and standards

Because these factors are interrelated, the owner, design engineer, operator, and builder must consider how these criteria affect each other. The relative importance of factors such as these varies with different owners, and can often change from one project to another for the same owner. For example, typical owner concerns include first cost compared to operating cost, extent and frequency of maintenance and whether that maintenance requires entering the occupied space, expected frequency of system failure, effect of failure, and time required to correct the failure. Each concern has a different priority, depending on the owner's goals.

Additional Goals

In addition to the primary goal of providing the desired environment, the design engineer should be aware of and account for other goals the owner may require. These goals may include the following:

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 9.1, Large Building Air-Conditioning Systems.

- Seasonal start-up date
- Occupant move-in date
- Operator training
- Supporting a process, such as operation of computer equipment
- Promoting a germ-free environment
- Increasing marketability of rental spaces
- Increasing net rental income
- Increasing property saleability
- Public image of the property
- Certification of energy use (LEED®, ENERGYSTAR®, etc.)

The owner can only make appropriate value judgments if the design engineer provides complete information on the advantages and disadvantages of each system option. Just as the owner does not usually know the relative advantages and disadvantages of different HVAC systems, the design engineer rarely knows all the owner's financial and functional goals. Hence, the owner must be proactive and involved in system selection in the conceptual phase of the job. The same can be said for operator participation so that the final design intent is sustainable and can continue to fulfill design intent.

All owners should request and/or require the design team to provide building and HVAC security (as defined in Chapter 61 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*). This security, in addition to environmental health and safety criteria, should address influences outside the building (e.g., smoke, toxic fumes, flood, etc.) as well as those inside the building. System selection pertaining to HVAC security may require another design team member, a security consultant, and/or the owner's own security group.

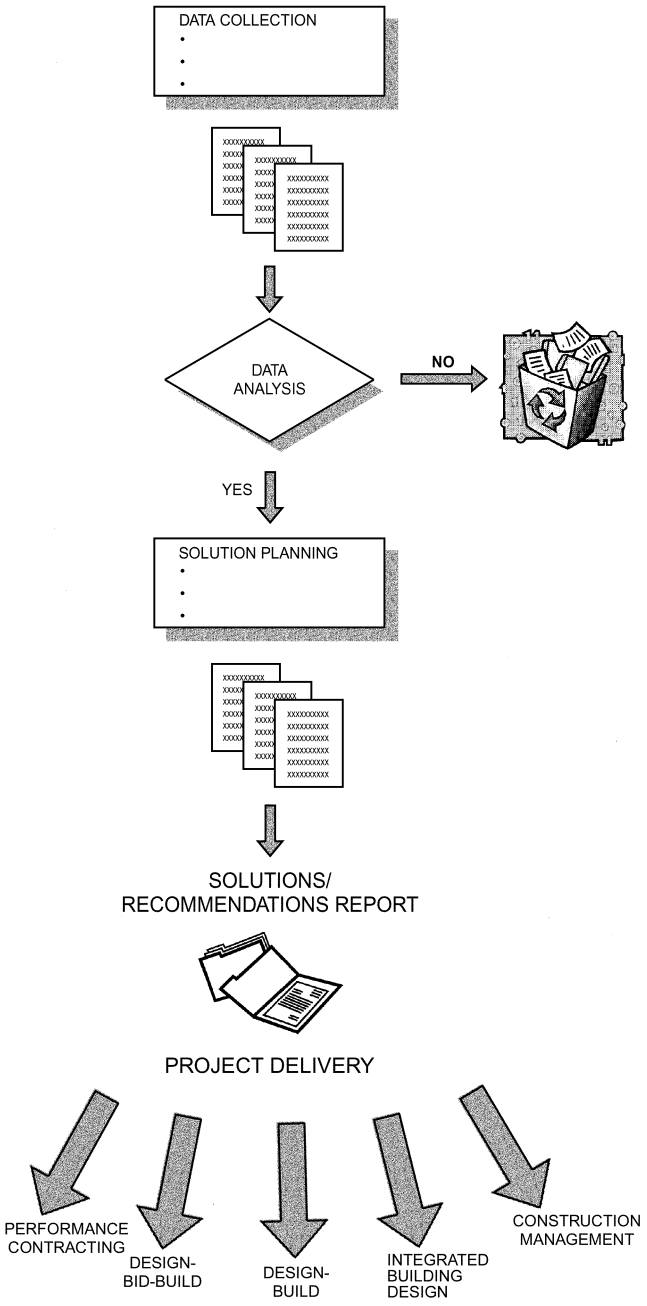

Fig. 1 Process Flow Diagram

Equipment and System Constraints

Once the goal criteria and additional goal options are verified, equipment and system constraints must be assessed and documented as part of the system analysis and selection recommendation report. These constraints may include the following:

- Performance limitations (e.g., temperature, humidity, space pressure, etc.)
- Code updates and/or new codes
- Available capacity including equipment size, as well as ductwork and/or pipe size
- Available space and access in and/or out with new or old equipment
- Available utility source
- Energy budget (e.g., conceptual W/m^2 per year), code-driven or targeted
- Equipment efficiency
- Operator knowledge and capabilities
- Existing building occupants
- Building architecture

Few projects allow detailed quantitative evaluation of all alternatives. Common sense, historical data, and subjective experience can be used to narrow choices to one or two potential systems. Heating and air-conditioning loads often contribute to constraints, narrowing the choice to systems that fit in available space and are compatible with building architecture. Chapters 17 and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describe methods to determine the size and characteristics of heating and air-conditioning loads. By establishing capacity requirements, equipment size can be determined, and the choice may be narrowed to those systems that work well on projects within the required size range.

Loads vary over time based on occupied and unoccupied periods, changes in weather, type of occupancy, activities, internal loads, and solar exposure. Each space with a different use and/or exposure may require its own control zone to maintain space comfort. Some areas with special requirements (e.g., dehumidification requirements) may need individual systems. The extent of zoning, degree of control required in each zone, and space required for individual zones also narrow system choices.

No matter how efficiently a particular system operates or how economical it is to install, it can only be considered if it (1) maintains the desired building space environment within an acceptable tolerance under expected conditions and occupant activities and (2) physically fits into, on, or adjacent to the building without causing objectionable occupancy conditions.

Cooling, heating, and humidity control are often the basis of sizing HVAC components and subsystems, but ventilation requirements can also significantly impact system sizing. For example, if large quantities of outdoor air are required for ventilation or to replace air exhausted from the building, the design engineer may only need to consider systems that transport and effectively condi-

tion those large outdoor air volumes, thus eliminating many of the other HVAC systems (e.g., unit ventilators, through-the-wall window units) from system consideration. The cooling, heating, humidification, and dehumidification delivery performance compromises may be minor for one application in a given climate, but may be unacceptable in another that has more stringent requirements.

HVAC systems and associated distribution systems often occupy a significant amount of space. Major components may also require special support from the structure. The size and appearance of terminal devices (e.g., grilles, registers, diffusers, fan-coil units, radiant panels, chilled beams) affect architectural design because they are visible in the occupied space, which constrains the design.

Sustainable energy consumption can be compromised and long-term project success lost if building operators are not trained to efficiently and effectively operate and maintain the building systems. For projects in which the design engineer used some form of energy software simulation, the resultant data should be passed on to the building owner so that goals and expectations can be measured and benchmarked against actual system performance. Even though the HVAC designer's work may be complete after system commissioning and turnover to the owner, continuous acceptable performance is expected and will only occur if the owner understands the background and systems selected and their anticipated performance. See ASHRAE *Guideline* 0 and to ASHRAE's Building Energy Quotient (bEQ) program (www.buildingeq.com).

System operability should be considered in system selection. Constructing a highly sophisticated, complex HVAC system in a building where maintenance personnel lack the required skills for maintenance can be a recipe for disaster at worst, and at best may require the use of costly outside maintenance and service contractors to achieve successful system operation.

The design engineer should closely coordinate the system constraints with the rest of the design team, as well as the owner, to overcome design obstacles associated with the HVAC systems under consideration for the project.

Constructability Constraints

The design engineer must take into account HVAC system constructability issues before the project reaches the construction document phase. Some of these constraints may significantly affect the success of the design and cannot be overlooked in the conceptual and design development phases. Some issues and concerns associated with constructability are

- Existing conditions (e.g., floor load, access into and through a building)
- Rigging equipment into and out of a building to a designated area
- Demolition and impact on adjacent space and existing systems in operation
- Maintaining existing building occupancy, use of the building, and system operation
- Ability to phase HVAC system installation
- Temporary HVAC
- Equipment availability (e.g., delivery lead time)
- Construction schedule
- Construction budget

It can be very advantageous to involve a builder into the early stages of an HVAC design to bring their prospective and experience to the project system analysis and selection process. Whether a construction manager, design-builder, or integrated project delivery leader, each brings years of experience to the topic of constructability that can influence the final selection of HVAC system(s).

Construction budget constraints can also influence the choice of HVAC systems. Based on historical data, some systems may not be economically viable within the budget limitations of an owner's building program. In addition, annual maintenance and operating budget (utilities, labor, and materials) can be limiting although more often than not, annual operating budgets do not get included in the total construction "soft costs" (e.g., furnishing, general conditions). This can be particularly important for building owners who will retain the building for a substantial number of years.The building's estimator can assist in the overall project cost by introducing value-engineered solutions that may involve (1) cost-driven performance, which may provide a better solution for lower first cost; (2) a more sustainable solution over the life of the equipment; or (3) best value based on a reasonable return on investment.

Narrowing the Choices

The following chapters in this volume present information to help the design engineer narrow the choices of HVAC systems:

- Chapter 2 focuses on a distributed approach to HVAC.
- Chapter 3 provides guidance for large equipment centrally located in or adjacent to a building.
- Chapters 4 to 18 address the numerous types of air-conditioning and heating systems.

Each chapter summarizes positive and negative features of various systems. Comparing the criteria, other factors and constraints, and their relative importance usually identifies one or two systems that best satisfy project goals. In making choices, notes should be kept on all systems considered and the reasons for eliminating those that are unacceptable.

Each selection may require combining a primary system with a secondary (or distribution) system. The primary system converts energy derived from fuel or electricity to produce a heating and/or cooling medium. The secondary system delivers heating, ventilation, cooling, humidification, and/or dehumidification to the occupied space. The systems are independent to a great extent, so several secondary systems may work with a particular primary system. In some cases, however, only one secondary system may be suitable for a particular primary system.

Once subjective analysis has identified one or more HVAC systems (sometimes only one choice remains), detailed quantitative evaluations must be made. All systems considered should provide satisfactory performance to meet the owner's essential goals. The design engineer should provide the owner with specific data on each system to make an informed choice. Consult the following chapters to help narrow the choices:

- Chapter 10 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* covers physiological principles, comfort, and health.
- Chapter 19 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* covers methods for estimating annual energy costs.
- Chapters 37 to 44 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* address important topics pertinent to the long-term success of building programs.

Other documents and guidelines that should be consulted are ASHRAE standards and guidelines; local, state, and federal guidelines; and special agency requirements (e.g., U.S. General Services Administration [GSA], Food and Drug Administration [FDA], Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations [JCAHO], Facility Guidelines Institute [FGI], Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design [LEED®]). Additional sources of detailed information are listed in the Bibliography and/or available in the ASHRAE Bookstore (www.ashrae.org/bookstore).

Selection Report

As the last step, the design engineer should prepare a system analysis and selection report in a format that incorporates the following:

- Introduction
- Building program primary HVAC goals
- Criteria for selection
- Important factors, including advantages and disadvantages

Table 1 Sample HVAC System Analysis and Selection Matrix (0 to 10 Score)

Goal: Furnish and install an HVAC system that provides moderate space temperature control with minimum humidity control at an operating budget of 220 kW/m^2 per year				
Categories	**System #1**	**System #2**	**System #3**	**Remarks**
1. Criteria for selection: • 25.6°C space temperature with ±1.7 K control during occupied cycle, with 40% rh and ±5% rh control during cooling. • 20°C space temperature with ±1 K, with 20% rh and ±5% rh control during heating season. • First cost • Equipment life cycle				
2. Important factors: • First-class office space stature • Individual tenant utility metering				
3. Other goals: • Engineered smoke control system • ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 ventilation rates • Direct digital control building automation				
4. System constraints: • No equipment on first floor • No equipment on ground adjacent to building				
5. Energy use as predicted by use of an industry-acceptable computerized energy model				
6. Other constraints: • No perimeter finned-tube radiation or other type of in-room equipment				
TOTAL SCORE				

- System integration with other building systems
- Other HVAC goals
- Security and environmental health and safety criteria
- Building envelope
- Project timeline (design, equipment delivery, commissioning, training, and construction)
- Basis of design
- HVAC system analysis and selection matrix
- System narratives
- Budget costs (first cost, operating cost, and energy cost)
- Final recommendation(s)

A brief outline of each of the final selections should be provided along with overall budget and/or cost per square metre. In addition, HVAC systems deemed inappropriate should be noted as having been considered but not found applicable to meet the owner's primary HVAC goal.

The report should include an HVAC system selection matrix that identifies the one or two suggested HVAC system selections (primary and secondary, when applicable), system constraints, and other constraints and considerations. In completing this matrix assessment, the design engineer should identify the owner's input to the analysis. This input can also be applied as weighted multipliers, because not all criteria carry the same weighted value.

Many grading methods are available to complete an analytical matrix analysis. Probably the simplest is to rate each item excellent, very good, good, fair, or poor. A numerical rating system such as 0 to 10, with 10 equal to excellent and 0 equal to poor or not applicable, can provide a quantitative result. The HVAC system with the highest numerical value then becomes the recommended system to accomplish the goal.

The system selection report should include a summary followed by a more detailed account of the HVAC system analysis and system selection. This summary should highlight key points and findings that led to the recommendation(s). The analysis should refer to the system selection matrix (such as in Table 1) and the reasons for scoring.

With each HVAC system considered, the design engineer should note the criteria associated with each selection. Issues such as close-tolerance temperature and humidity control may eliminate some HVAC systems from consideration. System constraints, noted with each analysis, may eliminate potential HVAC systems. Advantages and disadvantages of each system should be noted with the scoring from the HVAC system selection matrix. This process should reduce HVAC selection to one or two optimum choices for presentation to the owner. Examples of similar installations for other owners can be included with this report to support the final recommendation. Identifying a third party for an endorsement allows the owner to inquire about the success of other HVAC installations.

2. HVAC SYSTEMS AND EQUIPMENT

Many built, expanded, and/or renovated buildings may be ideally suited for decentralized HVAC systems, with equipment located in, throughout, adjacent to, or on top of the building. The alternative to this decentralized approach is to use primary equipment located in a central plant (either inside or outside the building) with water and/or air required for HVAC needs distributed from this plant.

Decentralized System Characteristics

The various types of decentralized systems are described in Chapter 2. The common element is that the required cooling is distributed throughout the building, generally with direct-expansion cooling, electric, or gas-fired heating of air systems, and on occasion, oil-fired warm-air heating units.

Temperature, Humidity, and Space Pressure Requirements. A decentralized system may be able to fulfill any or all of these design parameters, but typically not as efficiently or as accurately as a central system.

Capacity Requirements. A decentralized system usually requires each piece of equipment to be sized for zone peak capacity, unless the systems are variable-volume. Depending on equipment

type and location, decentralized systems do not benefit as much from equipment sizing diversity as centralized systems do.

Redundancy. A decentralized system may not have the benefit of back-up or standby equipment. This limitation may need review.

Facility Management. A decentralized system can allow the building manager to maximize performance using good business/facility management techniques in operating and maintaining the HVAC equipment and systems. With some decentralized equipment (e.g., rooftop HVAC units), operation and maintenance may be performed annually via a service contract with a mechanical contracting company.

Spatial Requirements. A decentralized system may or may not require equipment rooms. Because of space restrictions imposed on the design engineer or architect, equipment may be located on the roof and/or the ground adjacent to the building. Depending on system components, additional space may be required in the building for chillers and boilers. Likewise, a decentralized system may or may not require duct and pipe shafts throughout the building.

First Cost. A decentralized system probably has the best first-cost benefit. This feature can be enhanced by phasing in the purchase of decentralized equipment as needed (i.e., buying equipment as the building is being leased/occupied).

Operating Cost. A decentralized system can save operating cost by strategically starting and stopping multiple pieces of equipment. When comparing energy consumption based on peak energy draw, decentralized equipment may not be as attractive as larger, more energy-efficient centralized equipment.

Maintenance Cost. A decentralized system can save maintenance cost when equipment is conveniently located and equipment size and associated components (e.g., filters) are standardized. When equipment is located outdoors, maintenance may be difficult during bad weather.

Reliability. A decentralized system usually has reliable equipment, although the estimated equipment service life may be less than that of centralized equipment. Decentralized system equipment may, however, require maintenance in the occupied space.

Flexibility. A decentralized system may be very flexible because it may be placed in numerous locations.

Level of Control. Decentralized systems often use direct refrigerant expansion (DX) for cooling, and on/off or staged heat. This step control results in greater variation in space temperature and humidity, where close control is not desired or necessary. As a caution, oversizing DX or stepped cooling can allow high indoor humidity levels and mold or mildew problems.

Noise and Vibration. Decentralized systems often locate noisy machinery close to building occupants.

Constructability. Decentralized systems frequently consist of multiple and similar-in-size equipment that makes standardization a construction feature, as well as purchasing units in large quantities.

Centralized System Characteristics

These systems are characterized by central refrigeration equipment/systems with chilled-water distribution and central boiler equipment/system with hot-water distribution. Other central systems include low-, medium-, and high-pressure steam plants and cogeneration central equipment/systems, or condenser water systems used with water-source heat pumps.

Among the largest centralized systems are HVAC plants serving groups of large buildings. These plants improve diversity and generally operate more efficiently, and with lower maintenance costs, than individual central plants. Economic considerations of larger centralized systems require extensive analysis. The utility analysis may consider multiple fuels and may also include gas and steam turbine-driven equipment. Multiple types of primary equipment using multiple fuels and types of HVAC-generating equipment (e.g., centrifugal and absorption chillers) may be combined in one plant.

Temperature, Humidity, and Space Pressure Requirements. A central system may be able to fulfill any or all of these design parameters, typically with greater precision and efficiency than a decentralized system.

Capacity Requirements. A central system usually allows the design engineer to consider HVAC diversity factors that significantly reduce installed equipment capacity. As a result, this offers some attractive first-cost and operating-cost benefits.

Redundancy. A central system can accommodate standby equipment that decentralized configurations may have trouble accommodating because of cost.

Facility Management. A central system usually allows the building manager to maximize performance using good business/facility management techniques in operating and maintaining the HVAC equipment and systems. Operation and maintenance are usually handled by on-site staff, whether employees of the building owner or outsourced building management placed on site.

Spatial Requirements. The equipment room for a central system is normally located outside the conditioned area: in a basement, penthouse, service area, or adjacent to or remote from the building. A disadvantage of this approach may be the additional cost to furnish and install secondary equipment for the air and/or water distribution. Other considerations include access requirements and physical constraints that exist throughout the building to the installation of the secondary distribution network of ducts and/or pipes and for equipment replacement.

First Cost. Even with HVAC diversity, a central system may not be less costly than decentralized HVAC systems. Historically, central system equipment has a longer equipment service life to compensate for this shortcoming. Thus, a life-cycle cost analysis is very important when evaluating central versus decentralized systems.

Operating Cost. A central system usually has the advantage of larger, more energy-efficient primary equipment compared to decentralized system equipment. In addition, the availability of multiple pieces of HVAC equipment allows staging of this equipment operation to match building loads while maximizing operational efficiency.

Maintenance Cost. The equipment room for a central system provides the benefit of being able to maintain HVAC equipment away from occupants in an appropriate service work environment. Access to occupant workspace is not required, thus eliminating disruption to the space environment, product, or process. Because of the typically larger capacity of central equipment, there are usually fewer pieces of HVAC equipment to service.

Reliability. Centralized system equipment generally has a longer service life.

Flexibility. Flexibility can be a benefit when selecting equipment that provides an alternative or back-up source of HVAC.

Air Distribution Systems

The various air distribution systems, including dedicated outdoor air systems (DOAS), are detailed in Chapter 4; DOAS is also covered more thoroughly in Chapter 51. Any of the preceding system types discussed within this chapter can be used in conjunction with DOAS.

Level of Control. Centralized air systems generally use chilled water for cooling, and steam or hot water for heating. This usually allows for close control of space temperature and humidity where desired or necessary.

Sound and Vibration. Centralized air system placement should consider the associated equipment noise and vibration and locate machinery sufficiently remote from building occupants or noise-sensitive processes.

Constructability. Centralized air systems usually require more coordinated installation than decentralized systems. When reusing an existing central air fan(s) and associated ductwork, it is important to

verify construction class remains the same or is reduced (e.g., increasing supply air fan capacity in a project renovation may increase the fan construction from a Class 1 to a Class 2 construction). The same can be said when increasing airflow within an existing duct distribution system (e.g., ductwork may require reinforcement and/or duct seams sealed airtight due to the increase in duct static and velocity pressures).

Primary Equipment

The type of decentralized and centralized equipment selected for buildings depends on a well-organized HVAC analysis and selection report. The choice of primary equipment and components depends on factors presented in the selection report (see the section on Selecting a System). Primary HVAC equipment includes refrigeration equipment; heating equipment; and air, water, and steam delivery equipment.

Many HVAC designs recover internal heat from lights, people, and equipment to reduce the size of the heating plant. In buildings with core areas that require cooling while perimeter areas require heating, one of several heat reclaim systems can heat the perimeter to save energy. Sustainable design is also important when considering recovery and reuse of materials and energy. Chapter 9 describes heat pumps and some heat recovery arrangements, Chapter 37 describes solar energy equipment, and Chapter 26 introduces air-to-air energy recovery. In the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, Chapter 37 covers energy management and Chapter 42 covers building energy monitoring. Chapter 35 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* provides information on sustainable design, and Chapters 10 and 16 of that volume address indoor air quality, ventilation, and infiltration in the context of assessing optimum HVAC application options.

The search for energy savings has extended to **cogeneration** or **total energy (combined heat and power [CHP])** systems, in which on-site power generation is added to the HVAC project. The economic viability of this function is determined by the difference between gas and electric rates and by the ratio of electricity to heating demands for the project. In these systems, waste heat from generators can be transferred to the HVAC systems (e.g., to drive turbines of centrifugal compressors, serve an absorption chiller, provide heating or process steam). Chapter 7 covers cogeneration or total energy systems. Alternative fuel sources, such as waste heat boilers, are now included in fuel evaluation and selection for HVAC applications.

Thermal storage is another cost-saving concept, which provides the possibility of off-peak generation of chilled water or ice. Thermal storage can also be used for storing hot water for heating. Many electric utilities impose severe charges for peak summer power use or offer incentives for off-peak use. Storage capacity installed to level the summer load may also be available for use in winter, thus making heat reclaim a viable option. Chapter 50 has more information on thermal storage.

With ice storage, colder supply air can be provided than that available from a conventional chilled-water system. This colder air allows use of smaller fans and ducts, which reduces first cost and (in some locations) operating cost. Additional pipe and duct insulation is often required, however, contributing to a higher first cost. These life-cycle savings can offset the first cost for storage provisions and the energy cost required to make ice. Similarly, thermal storage of hot water can be used for heating.

Refrigeration Equipment

Chapters 2 and 3 summarize the primary types of refrigeration equipment for HVAC systems.

When chilled water is supplied from a central plant, as on university campuses and in downtown areas of large cities or in large buildings, the utility service provider should be contacted during system analysis and selection to determine availability, cost, and the specific requirements of the service.

Heating Equipment

Steam boilers and heating-water boilers are the primary means of heating a space using a centralized system, as well as some decentralized systems. These boilers may be (1) used both for comfort and process heating; (2) manufactured to produce high- or low-pressure steam; and (3) fired with coal, oil, electricity, gas, and even some waste materials. Low-pressure boilers are rated for a working pressure of 100 kPa for steam, and 1100 kPa for water, with a temperature limit of 120°C. Packaged boilers, with all components and controls assembled at the factory as a unit, are available. Electrode or resistance electric boilers that generate either steam or hot water are also available. Chapter 32 has further information on boilers, and Chapter 27 details air-heating coils.

Where steam, hot water, or chilled water is supplied from a central plant, as on university campuses and in downtown areas of large cities, the utility provider should be contacted during project system analysis and selection to determine availability, cost, and specific requirements of the service.

When primary heating equipment is selected, the fuels considered must ensure maximum efficiency. Chapter 31 discusses design, selection, and operation of the burners for different types of primary heating equipment. Chapter 28 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describes types of fuel, fuel properties, and proper combustion factors.

Air Delivery Equipment

Primary air delivery equipment for HVAC systems is classified as packaged, manufactured and custom-manufactured, or field-fabricated (built-up). Most air delivery equipment for large systems uses centrifugal or axial fans; however, plug or plenum fans are often used. Centrifugal fans are frequently used in packaged and manufactured HVAC equipment. One system rising in popularity is a fan array, which uses multiple plug fans on a common plenum wall, thus reducing unit size. Axial fans are more often part of a custom unit or a field-fabricated unit. Both types of fans can be used as industrial process and high-pressure blowers. Chapter 21 describes fans, and Chapters 19 and 20 provide information about air delivery components.

3. SPACE REQUIREMENTS

In the initial phase of building design, the design engineer seldom has sufficient information to render the optimum HVAC design for the project, and its space requirements are often based on percentage of total area or other experiential rules of thumb. The final design is usually a compromise between the engineer's recommendations and the architectural considerations that can be accommodated in the building. An integrated project design (IPD) approach, as recommended by the American Institute of Architects (AIA), can address these problems early in the design process; also see Chapter 60 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*. Other times, the building owner may prefer either a centralized or decentralized system and dictate final design and space requirements. This section discusses some of these requirements.

Equipment Rooms

Total mechanical and electrical space requirements range between 4 and 9% of gross building area, with most buildings in the 6 to 9% range. These ranges include space for HVAC, electrical, plumbing, and fire protection equipment and may also include vertical shaft space for mechanical and electrical distribution through the building.

Most equipment rooms should be centrally located to (1) minimize long duct, pipe, and conduit runs and sizes; (2) simplify shaft layouts; and (3) centralize maintenance and operation. With shorter duct and pipe runs, a central location could also reduce pump and fan motor power requirements, which reduces building operating costs. But, for many reasons, not all mechanical and electrical equipment rooms can be centrally located in the building. In any case, equipment should be kept together whenever possible to minimize space requirements, centralize maintenance and operation, and simplify the electrical system.

Equipment rooms generally require clear ceiling height ranging from 3 to 5 m, depending on equipment sizes and the complexity of air and/or water distribution.

The main electrical transformer and switchgear rooms should be located as close to the incoming electrical service as practical. If there is an emergency generator, it should be located considering (1) proximity to emergency electrical loads and sources of combustion and cooling air and fuel, (2) ease of properly venting exhaust gases to the outdoors, and (3) provisions for noise control. Noise control is generally a minor issue because equipment only runs during emergencies.

Primary Equipment Rooms. The heating equipment room houses the boiler(s) and possibly a boiler feed unit (for steam boilers), chemical treatment equipment, pumps, heat exchangers, pressure-reducing equipment, air compressors, and miscellaneous ancillary equipment. The refrigeration equipment room houses the chiller(s) and possibly chilled-water and condenser water pumps, heat exchangers, air-conditioning equipment, air compressors, and miscellaneous ancillary equipment, and in some cases, direct-expansion compressors. Design of these rooms needs to consider (1) equipment size and weight, (2) installation, maintenance, and replacement, (3) applicable regulations relative to combustion air and ventilation air, and (4) noise and vibration transmission to adjacent spaces. Consult ASHRAE *Standard* 15 for refrigeration equipment room safety requirements. Note that primary equipment rooms should not be located below ground or even at ground level if the project is to be located in a designated flood zone area, due to the potential of the equipment room being flooded.

Many air-conditioned buildings require a cooling tower or other type of heat rejection equipment. If the cooling tower or water-cooled condenser is located at ground level, it should be at least 30 m away from the building to reduce tower noise in the building, and to keep discharge air and moisture carryover from fogging the building's windows and discoloring the building facade or from contaminating outdoor air being introduced into the building. Cooling towers should be kept a similar distance from parking lots to avoid staining car finishes with atomized water treatment chemicals. Chapter 40 has further information on this equipment.

It is often economical to locate the heating and/or refrigeration plant in the building, on an intermediate floor, in a roof penthouse, or on the roof when roof space is available; air-cooled refrigeration systems can be considered. Electrical service and structural costs are higher, but these may be offset by reduced costs for piping, pumps and pumping energy, and chimney requirements for fuel-fired boilers. Also, initial cost of equipment in a tall building may be less for equipment located on a higher floor (e.g., boilers located in a roof penthouse of a high-rise building) because some operating pressures may be lower.

Regulations applicable to both gas and fuel oil systems must be followed. Gas fuel may be more desirable than fuel oil because of the physical constraints on the required fuel oil storage tank, as well as specific environmental and safety concerns related to oil leaks. Also, the cost of an oil leak detection and prevention system may be substantial. Oil pumping presents added design and operating problems, depending on location of the oil tank relative to the oil burner.

Energy recovery systems can reduce the size of the heating and/or refrigeration plant. The possibility of failure or the need to take heat recovery equipment out of operation for service should be considered in the heating plant design, to ensure the ability to heat the building with the heating plant without heat recovery. Well-insulated buildings and electric and gas utility rate structures may encourage the design engineer to consider energy conservation concepts such as limiting demand, ambient cooling, and thermal storage.

Fan Rooms

Fan rooms house HVAC air delivery equipment and may include other miscellaneous equipment. The room must have space for removing the fan(s), shaft(s), coils, and filters. Installation, replacement, and maintenance of this equipment should be considered when locating and arranging the room.

Fan rooms in a basement that has an airway for intake of outdoor air present a potential problem. Low air intakes are a security concern, because harmful substances could easily be introduced (see the section on Security). Debris, and in some climate zones snow, may fill the area, resulting in safety, health, and fan performance concerns. Parking areas close to the building's outdoor air intake may compromise ventilation air quality.

Fan rooms located at the perimeter wall can have intake and exhaust louvers at the location of the fan room, subject to coordination with architectural considerations. Interior fan rooms often require intake and exhaust shafts from the roof because of the difficulty (typically caused by limited ceiling space) in ducting intake and exhaust to the perimeter wall.

Fan rooms on the second floor and above have easier access for outdoor and exhaust air. Depending on the fan room location, equipment replacement may be easier. The number of fan rooms required depends largely on the total floor area and whether the HVAC system is centralized or decentralized. Buildings with large floor areas may have multiple decentralized fan rooms on each or alternate floors. High-rise buildings may opt for decentralized fan rooms for each floor, or for more centralized service with one fan room serving the lower 10 to 20 floors, one serving the middle floors of the building, and one at the roof serving the top floors.

Life safety is a very important factor in HVAC fan room location. Chapter 54 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* discusses fire and smoke control. State and local codes have additional fire and smoke detection and damper criteria. Building codes that require smoke control and building pressurization should be accounted for in equipment selection.

Horizontal Distribution

Most decentralized and central systems rely on horizontal distribution. To accommodate this need, the design engineer needs to take into account the duct and/or pipe distribution criteria for installation in a ceiling space or below a raised floor space. Systems using water distribution usually require the least amount of ceiling or raised floor depth, whereas air distribution systems have the largest demand for horizontal distribution height. Steam systems need to accommodate pitch of steam pipe, end of main drip, and condensate return pipe pitch. Another consideration in the horizontal space cavity is accommodating the structural members, light fixtures, rain leaders, cable trays, etc., that can fill up this space.

Vertical Shafts

Buildings over two stories high usually require vertical shafts to consolidate mechanical (e.g., air distribution ducts and pipes), electrical, plumbing, and telecommunication distribution through the facility.

Air distribution includes HVAC supply, return, and exhaust air ductwork. If a shaft is used as a return air plenum, close coordina-

tion with the architect is necessary to ensure that the shaft is airtight. If the shaft is used to convey outdoor air to decentralized systems, close coordination with the architect is also necessary to ensure that the shaft is constructed to meet mechanical code requirements and to accommodate the anticipated internal pressure. The temperature of air in the shaft must be considered when using the shaft enclosure to convey outdoor air. Pipe distribution includes heating, chilled, and condenser water, and steam supply and condensate return. It may also include fuel oil and gas pumping. Other distribution systems found in vertical shafts or located vertically in the building include electric conduits/bus ducts/closets, telephone cabling/closets, uninterruptible power supply (UPS), plumbing, fire protection piping, pneumatic tubes, and conveyors.

Vertical shafts should not be adjacent to stairs, electrical closets, and elevators unless at least two sides are available to allow access to ducts, pipes, and conduits that enter and exit the shaft while allowing maximum headroom at the ceiling. In general, duct shafts with an aspect ratio of 2:1 to 4:1 are easier to develop than large square shafts. The rectangular shape also facilitates transition from the equipment in the fan rooms to the shafts. In addition, significant space is required for motorized and fire/smoke dampers when ducts leave shafts.

In multistory buildings, a central vertical distribution system with minimal horizontal branch ducts is desirable. This arrangement (1) is usually less costly; (2) is easier to balance; (3) creates less conflict with pipes, beams, and lights; and (4) enables the architect to design lower floor-to-floor heights. These advantages also apply to vertical water and steam pipe distribution systems.

The number of shafts is a function of building size and shape. In larger buildings, it is usually more economical in cost and space to have several small shafts rather than one large shaft. Separate HVAC supply, return, and exhaust air duct shafts may be desirable to reduce the number of duct crossovers. The same applies for steam supply and condensate return pipe shafts because the pipe must be pitched in the direction of flow.

When future expansion is a consideration, a pre-agreed percentage of additional shaft space should be considered for inclusion. This, however, affects the building's first cost because of the additional floor space that must be constructed. The need for access doors into shafts and gratings at various locations throughout the height of the shaft should also be considered.

Rooftop Equipment

For buildings three stories or less, system analysis and selection frequently locates HVAC equipment on the roof or another outdoor location, where the equipment is exposed to the weather. Decentralized equipment and systems are sometimes more advantageous than centralized HVAC for smaller buildings, particularly those with multiple tenants with different HVAC needs. Selection of rooftop equipment is usually driven by first cost versus operating cost and/or maximum service life of the equipment. For buildings with larger floor plates, centralized equipment may be advantageous and should be considered.

Equipment Access

Properly designed mechanical and electrical equipment rooms must allow for movement of large, heavy equipment in, out, and through the building. If a building is being renovated for another application, floor loading should be assessed to determine whether heavier equipment can be installed on the existing floor. Equipment replacement and maintenance can be very costly if access is not planned properly. Access to rooftop equipment should be by means of, at a minimum, a ship's ladder and not by a vertical ladder, taking into account a technician carrying boxes of replacement filters. Use caution when accessing equipment on sloped roofs.

Because systems vary greatly, it is difficult to estimate space requirements for refrigeration and boiler rooms without making block layouts of the system selected. Block layouts allow the design engineer to develop the most efficient arrangement of the equipment with adequate access and serviceability. Block layouts can also be used in preliminary discussions with the owner and architect. Only then can the design engineer verify the estimates and provide a workable and economical design.

4. AIR DISTRIBUTION

Ductwork should deliver conditioned air to an area as directly, quietly, and economically as possible. Structural features of the building generally require some compromise and often limit the depth of space available for ducts. Chapter 10 discusses air distribution design for small heating and cooling systems. Chapters 20 and 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* discuss space air distribution and duct design.

The design engineer must coordinate duct layout with the structure as well as other mechanical, electrical, plumbing, and communication systems. In commercial projects, the design engineer is usually encouraged to reduce floor-to-floor dimensions: with the resulting decrease in available interstitial space, depth for ducts is a major design challenge. In institutional and information technology buildings, higher floor-to-floor heights are required because of the sophisticated, complex mechanical, electrical, and communication distribution systems.

Exhaust systems, especially those serving fume exhaust, grease exhaust, dust and/or particle collection, and other process exhaust, require special design considerations. Capture velocity, duct material, and pertinent duct fittings and fabrication are a few of the design parameters necessary for this type of distribution system to function properly, efficiently, and per applicable codes. See Chapters 15 to 33 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for additional information on industrial applications.

Air Terminal Units

In some instances, such as in low-velocity, all-air systems, air may enter from the supply air ductwork directly into the conditioned space through a grille, register, or diffuser. In medium- and high-velocity air systems, an intermediate device normally controls air volume, reduces air pressure from the duct to the space, or both. Various types of air terminal units are available, including (1) a fan-powered terminal unit, which uses an integral fan to mix ceiling plenum air and primary air from the central or decentralized fan system rather than depending on induction (mixed air terminal unit) delivering to low-pressure ductwork and then to the space); (2) a variable-air-volume (VAV) terminal unit, which varies the amount of air delivered to the space (this air may be delivered to low-pressure ductwork and then to the space, or the terminal may contain an integral air diffuser); or (3) other in-room terminal type (see Chapter 5). Chapter 20 has more information about air terminal units.

See Chapters 20 and 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for information on space air diffusion and duct design.

Duct Insulation

In new construction and renovation upgrade projects, HVAC supply air ducts should be insulated and sealed in accordance with energy code requirements. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 and Chapter 23 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* have more information about insulation and calculation methods.

Ceiling and Floor Plenums

Frequently, the space between the suspended ceiling and the floor slab above it is used as a return air plenum to reduce distribution ductwork. Check regulations before using this approach in new

construction or renovation because most codes prohibit combustible material in a ceiling return air plenum. Ceiling plenums and raised floors can also be used for supply air displacement systems to minimize horizontal distribution, along with other features discussed in Chapter 4.

Some ceiling plenum applications with lay-in panels do not work well where the stack effect of a high-rise building or high-rise elevators creates a negative pressure. If the plenum leaks to the low-pressure area, tiles may lift and drop out when the outside door is opened and closed.

The air temperature in a return air plenum directly below a roof deck is usually higher by 2 to 3 K during the air-conditioning season than in a ducted return. This can be an advantage to the occupied space below because heat gain to the space is reduced. Conversely, return air plenums directly below a roof deck have lower return air temperatures during the heating season than a ducted return and may require supplemental heat in the plenum.

Using a raised floor for air distribution is popular for computer rooms and cleanrooms, and is now being used in other HVAC applications. Underfloor air displacement (UFAD) systems in office buildings use the raised floor as a supply air plenum, which could reduce overall first cost of construction and ongoing improvement costs for occupants. Making the underfloor supply air plenum as airtight as possible is critical to the success of this type of plenum. This UFAD system improves air circulation to the occupied area of the space. See Chapter 20 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* and Chapter 20 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for more information on displacement ventilation and underfloor air distribution.

5. PIPE DISTRIBUTION

Piping should deliver refrigerant, heating water, chilled water, condenser water, fuel oil, gas, steam, and condensate drainage and return to and from HVAC equipment as directly, quietly, and economically as possible. Structural features of the building generally require mechanical and electrical coordination to accommodate P-traps, pipe pitch-draining of low points in the system, and venting of high points. When assessing application of pipe distribution to air distribution, the floor-to-floor height requirement can influence the pipe system: it requires less ceiling space to install pipe when compared to air ductwork. An alternative to horizontal piping is vertical pipe distribution, which may further reduce floor-to-floor height criteria. See Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for pipe sizing.

Pipe Systems

HVAC piping systems can be divided into two parts: (1) piping in the central plant equipment room and (2) piping required to deliver refrigerant, heating water, chilled water, condenser water, fuel oil, gas, steam, and condensate drainage and return to and from decentralized HVAC and process equipment throughout the building. Chapters 11 to 15 discuss piping for various heating and cooling systems. Chapters 1 to 4 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* discuss refrigerant system design and practices.

Pipe Insulation

In new construction and renovation projects, most HVAC piping must be insulated. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 and Chapter 23 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* have information on insulation and calculation methods. In most applications, water-source heat pump loop piping and condenser water piping may not need to be insulated.

6. SECURITY AND ENVIRONMENTAL HEALTH AND SAFETY

Since September 11, 2001, much attention has been given to protecting buildings against terrorist attacks via their HVAC systems. The first consideration should be to perform a risk assessment of the particular facility, which may be based on usage, size, population, and/or significance. The risk assessment is a subjective judgment by the building owner (and sometimes by a registered/certified security professional) of whether the building is at low, medium, or high risk. An example of low-to-medium risk buildings may be suburban office buildings, shopping malls, hospitals, educational institutions, or major office buildings. High-risk buildings may include major government buildings. The level of protection designed into these buildings may include enhanced particulate filtration, gaseous-phase filtration, and various control schemes to allow purging of the facility using either the HVAC system or an independent dedicated system.

Enhanced particulate filtration for air-handling systems to the level of MERV 14 to 16 filters not only tends to reduce circulation of dangerous substances (e.g., anthrax), but also provides better indoor air quality (IAQ). Gaseous-phase filtration can remove harmful substances such as sarin and other gaseous threats. For buildings of all risk levels, consideration should include proper location of outdoor air intakes to account for other security concerns, such as toxic fumes from a local accident (e.g., punctured tank from a nearby railroad car or tanker truck). The extent to which the HVAC system designer should use these measures could depend on the recommendations of an experienced security and environmental health and safety consultant or agency.

In any building, consideration should be given to protecting outdoor air intakes against insertion of dangerous materials by locating the intakes on the roof or substantially above grade level. Separate systems for mailrooms, loading docks, and other similar spaces should be considered so that any dangerous material received cannot be spread throughout the building from these types of vulnerable spaces. Emergency ventilation systems for these types of spaces should be designed so that upon detection of suspicious material, toxic fumes, or chemical spill, these spaces can be quickly purged and maintained at a negative pressure.

A more extensive discussion of this topic can be found in ASHRAE's *Guideline* 29. Note, however, that fan energy required to move air through these high efficiency filters is very significant.

7. AUTOMATIC CONTROLS AND BUILDING MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS

Basic HVAC system controls are primarily direct digital controls (DDC), but there are also electric, electronic, and pneumatic controls (found largely as part of existing building HVAC systems). Depending on the application, the design engineer may recommend a simple and basic system strategy as a cost-effective solution to an owner's heating, ventilation, and cooling needs. Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* and Chapter 7 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* discuss automatic control in more detail.

The next level of HVAC system management is DDC wireless systems. Many DDC installations will use either pneumatic or electric control damper and valve actuators. This automatic control enhancement may include energy monitoring and energy management software. Controls may also be accessible by the building manager using a modem to a remote computer at an off-site location or via a smartphone or tablet computer with Internet connection to the control system. Building size has little to no effect on modern computerized controls: programmable controls can be furnished on the smallest HVAC equipment for the smallest projects. Chapter 43

of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* covers building operating dynamics.

Automatic controls often come prepackaged and prewired on the HVAC equipment, creating a design challenge to have the equipment communicate with a third party building automation system (BAS). Current HVAC controls and their capabilities need to be compatible with other new and existing automatic controls. Chapter 41 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* discusses computer applications, and ASHRAE *Standard* 135 discusses interfacing building automation systems. Furthermore, compatibility with BACnet® and/or LonWorks® provides an additional level of compatibility between equipment made by numerous manufacturers.

Using computers and proper software, the design engineer and building manager can provide complete facility management, as well as remote facility management. A comprehensive building management system (BMS) may include HVAC system control, energy management, operation and maintenance management, medical gas system monitoring, fire alarm system, security system, lighting control, and other reporting and trending software. This system may also be integrated and accessible from the owner's computer network and the Internet.

The automatic control system can be as simple as a time clock to start and stop equipment, or as sophisticated as computerized building automation serving a decentralized HVAC system, multiple building systems, central plant system, and/or a large campus. With a focus on energy management, the building management system can be an important business tool in achieving sustainable facility management that begins with using the system selection matrix.

8. MAINTENANCE MANAGEMENT

Whereas BMS focus on operation of HVAC, electrical, plumbing, and other systems, maintenance management systems focus on maintaining assets, which include mechanical and electrical systems along with the building structure. A rule of thumb is that only about 20% of the cost of the building is in the first cost, with the other 80% being operation, maintenance, and rejuvenation of the building and building systems over the life cycle. When considering the optimum HVAC selection and recommendation at the start of a project, a maintenance management system should be considered for HVAC systems with an estimated long useful service life.

Another maintenance management business tool is a **computerized maintenance management software (CMMS)** system. The CMMS system can include an equipment database, parts and material inventory, project management software, labor records, etc., pertinent to sustainable management of the building over its life. CMMS also can integrate computer-aided drawing (CAD), building information modeling (BIM), digital photography and audio/video systems, equipment run-time monitoring and trending, and other proactive facility management systems.

In scoring the HVAC system selection matrix, consideration should also be given to the potential for interface of the BMS with the CMMS. In addition, onboard equipment diagnostics and remote troubleshooting capabilities as part of considering the optimum HVAC selection.

Planning in the design phase and the early compilation of record documents (e.g., computer-aided drawing and electronic text files, checklists, digital photos taken during construction) are also integral to successful building management and maintenance. The use of bar coding equipment, valves, etc., can link them to the CMMS via an Internet-accessed scanner.

9. BUILDING SYSTEM COMMISSIONING

When compiling data to complete the HVAC system selection matrix to analytically determine the optimum HVAC system for the project, a design engineer should begin to produce the design intent document/basis of design that identifies the project goals. This process is the beginning of building system commissioning and should be an integral part of the project documentation. As design progresses and the contract documents take shape, the commissioning process continues to be built into what eventually becomes the final commissioning report, approximately one year after the construction phase has been completed and the warranty phase comes to an end. For more information, see Chapter 44 in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* or ASHRAE *Guideline* 1.1.

Building commissioning contributes to successful sustainable HVAC design by incorporating the system training requirements necessary for building management staff to efficiently take over ownership, operation, and maintenance of the HVAC systems over the installation's useful service life.

Building system commissioning is often contracted directly by an owner and is required by many standards to achieve peak building system performance. Review in the design phase of a project should consider both commissioning and air and water balancing, which should continue through the construction and warranty phases. For additional information, refer to ASHRAE *Guideline* 0.

With building certification programs (e.g., ASHRAE's bEQ, LEED®), commissioning is a prerequisite because of the importance of ensuring that high-performance energy and environmental designs are long-term successes.

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CHAPTER 2

DECENTRALIZED COOLING AND HEATING

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FOR MOST small to mid-sized installations, decentralized cooling and heating is usually preferable to a centralized system (see Chapter 3). Frequently classified as packaged unit systems (although many are far from being a single packaged unit), decentralized systems can be found in almost all classes of buildings. They are especially suitable for smaller projects with no central plant, where low initial cost and simplified installation are important. These systems are installed in office buildings, shopping centers, manufacturing plants, schools, health care facilities, hotels, motels, apartments, nursing homes, and other multiple-occupancy dwellings. They are also suited to air conditioning existing buildings with limited life or income potential. Applications also include facilities requiring specialized high performance levels, such as computer rooms and research laboratories.

Although some of the equipment addressed here can be applied as a single unit, this chapter covers applying multiple units to form a complete heating and air-conditioning system for a building and the distribution associated with some of these systems. For guidance on HVAC system selection, see Chapter 1.

1. SYSTEM CHARACTERISTICS

Decentralized systems can be one or more individual HVAC units, each with an integral refrigeration cycle, heating source, and direct or indirect outdoor air ventilation. Components are factory-designed and assembled into a package that includes fans, filters, heating source, cooling coil, refrigerant compressor(s), controls, and condenser. Equipment is manufactured in various configurations to meet a wide range of applications. Examples of decentralized HVAC equipment include the following:

- Window air conditioners
- Through-the-wall room HVAC units
- Air-cooled heat pump systems
- Water-cooled heat pump systems
- Multiple-unit systems
- Residential and light commercial split systems
- Self-contained (floor-by-floor) systems
- Outdoor package systems
- Packaged, special-procedure units (e.g., for computer rooms)
- Single-zone variable-air-volume systems
- Variable-refrigerant-flow systems

For details on window air conditioners and through-the-wall units, see Chapter 49. For variable-refrigerant-flow systems, see Chapter 18; the other examples listed here are discussed further in Chapter 48. (Multiple-unit systems are also covered in Chapter 4.)

Commercial-grade unitary equipment packages are available only in preestablished increments of capacity with set performance parameters, such as the sensible heat ratio at a given room condition or the airflow per kilowatt of refrigeration capacity. Components are matched and assembled to achieve specific performance objectives. These limitations make manufacture of low-cost, quality-controlled, factory-tested products practical. For a particular kind and capacity of unit, performance characteristics vary among manufacturers. All characteristics should be carefully assessed to ensure that the equipment performs as needed for the application. Several trade associations have developed standards by which manufacturers may test and rate their equipment. See Chapters 48 and 49 for more specific information on pertinent industry standards and on decentralized cooling and heating equipment used in multiple-packaged unitary systems.

Large commercial/industrial-grade packaged equipment can be custom-designed by the factory to meet specific design conditions and job requirements. This equipment carries a higher first cost and is not readily available in smaller sizes.

Self-contained units, often called rooftop units, can use multiple compressors to control refrigeration capacity. For variable-air-volume (VAV) systems, compressors are turned on or off or unloaded to maintain discharge air temperature. Variable-speed compressors can be factory integrated for close control. As zone demand decreases, the temperature of air leaving the unit can often be reset upward so that a minimum ventilation rate is maintained.

Multiple packaged-unit systems for perimeter spaces are frequently combined with a central all-air or floor-by-floor system. These combinations can provide better humidity control, air purity, and ventilation than packaged units alone. Air-handling systems may also serve interior building spaces that cannot be conditioned by wall or window-mounted units.

Water-source heat pump systems often combine packaged units (heat pumps) with a central piping system for heat rejection and heat gain. These systems require heat rejection equipment (ground source or cooling tower) and heat source (ground source or boiler) provided separately from the packaged heat pump.

Heating can be included in a packaged unit. Gas heat exchangers or electric heat coils can be provided. Heat can be turned on or off in stages to meet zone demands. In some applications, heat from a centralized source, like a boiler system, is combined with decentralized packaged units, and steam or hot-water coils can be factory mounted in packaged units for connection to local piping systems.

For supplementary data on air-side design of decentralized systems, see Chapter 4.

Advantages

- Heating and cooling can be provided at all times, independent of the mode of operation of other building spaces.
- Manufacturer-matched components have certified ratings and performance data.
- Assembly by a manufacturer helps ensure better quality control and reliability.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 9.1, Large Building Air-Conditioning Systems.

- Manufacturer instructions and multiple-unit arrangements simplify installation through repetition of tasks.
- Only one zone of temperature control is affected if equipment malfunctions.
- The equipment is readily available.
- Multiple vendors manufacture similar equipment, providing multiple sources.
- One manufacturer is responsible for the final equipment package.
- For improved energy control, equipment serving vacant spaces can be turned off locally or from a central point, without affecting occupied spaces.
- System operation is simple. Trained operators are not usually required.
- Less mechanical and electrical room space is required than with central systems.
- Initial cost is usually low.
- Equipment can be installed to condition one space at a time as a building is completed, remodeled, or as individual areas are occupied, with favorable initial investment.
- Energy can be metered directly to each tenant.
- Air- or water-side economizers may be applicable based on the unit capacity, depending on type of decentralized system used.
- High-efficiency units with advanced controls are available from several manufacturers.

Disadvantages

- Performance options may be limited because airflow, cooling coil size, and condenser size are often fixed. Variable-speed fan and compressor control may be available.
- Larger total building installed cooling capacity is usually required because diversity factors used for moving cooling needs do not apply to multiple dedicated packages.
- Temperature and humidity control may be less stable, especially with mechanical cooling at very low loads.
- Standard commercial units are not generally suited for large percentages of outdoor air or for close humidity control. Custom or special-purpose equipment, such as packaged units for computer rooms, hot-gas reheat for dehumidification, or large custom units, may be required.
- Energy use is usually greater than for central systems if efficiency of the unitary equipment is less than that of the combined central system components.
- Low-cost cooling by economizers may not be available or practical.
- Air distribution design may be limited by fan capacity available.
- Operating sound levels can be high, and noise-producing machinery is often closer to building occupants than with central systems.
- Ventilation capabilities may be limited by equipment selection and design.
- Equipment can make the building less aesthetically pleasing.
- Air filtration options may be limited.
- Discharge temperature varies because of on/off or step control.
- Condensate drain is required with each air-conditioning unit.
- Maintenance may be difficult or costly because of multiple pieces of equipment and their location.

2. DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

Rating classifications and typical sizes for equipment addressed in this chapter can be found in Chapters 48 and 49, which also address available components, equipment selection, distribution piping, and ductwork.

Selection of a decentralized system should follow guidance provided in Chapter 1. The design engineer can use the HVAC system analysis selection matrix to analytically assess and select the optimum decentralized system for the project. Combined with the design criteria in Chapters 48 and 49, the basis of design can be documented.

Unlike centralized cooling and heating equipment, capacity diversity is limited with decentralized equipment, because each piece of equipment must be sized for peak capacity.

For indoor decentralized refrigeration systems, each refrigeration system must be treated independently with regard to compliance with ASHRAE *Standard* 15 requirements; this may complicate individual mechanical room exhaust and air exchange.

Noise from this type of equipment may be objectionable and should be checked to ensure it meets sound level requirements. Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* has more information on HVAC-related sound and vibration concerns.

Decentralized packaged equipment requires design consideration because the building structure must support the units: a typical full compressorized package unit weighs more than a similarly sized air-handling-only system.

When packaged units are located outdoors, designers must consider weather conditions and accommodate rain, snow, or high winds. Outdoor packaged units can conveniently be provided with integrated outdoor air intakes or air economizers. Gas-fired furnaces on outdoor package units can be vented directly from the unit.

When packaged units are located indoors, the designer must consider a separate source for ventilation air and/or economizer. Gas heat might be limited by combustion air source and available flue pathways. When split-system packaged units are used, design limitations for refrigerant piping and distances must be considered.

Design must consider noise generated by packaged unit's compressors, fans, or both. Units mounted on roofs should not be located above sound-sensitive spaces, such as conference rooms or sleeping areas. Units inside the building might require enclosure in a mechanical room or closets with sound-absorbing wall construction.

Decentralized units require electric and/or gas to each location. Designers must consider building type and installation costs for the utilities in addition to the HVAC system cost.

Air-Side Economizer

With some decentralized systems, an air-side economizer is an option, if not an energy code requirement (check state code for criteria). The air-side economizer uses cool outdoor air to either assist mechanical cooling or, if the outdoor air is cool enough, provide total cooling. It requires a mixing box designed to allow 100% of the supply air to be drawn from the outdoors. See Chapter 43 in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for additional information on control of economizer cooling. Decentralized systems can be selected with a field-installed accessory that includes an outdoor air damper, relief damper, return air damper, filter, actuator, and linkage. Controls are usually a factory-installed option. Dampers must be the low-leakage type.

Self-contained units usually do not include return air fans. A barometric relief, fan-powered relief fan, or return/exhaust fan may be provided as an air-side economizer. The relief fan is off and discharge/exhaust dampers are closed when the air-side economizer is inactive.

Advantages

- Substantially reduces compressor, cooling tower, and condenser water pump energy requirements, generally saving more energy than a water-side economizer.
- Has a lower air-side pressure drop than a water-side economizer.
- Reduces tower makeup water and related water treatment.
- May improve indoor air quality by providing large amounts of outdoor air during mild weather.

Disadvantages

- In systems with larger return air static pressure requirements, return or exhaust fans are needed to properly exhaust building air and take in outdoor air.
- If the unit's leaving air temperature is also reset up during the air-side economizer cycle, humidity control problems may occur and the fan may use more energy, unless a return air humidity sensor resets the supply air discharge temperature.
- Humidification may be required during winter.
- More and/or larger air intake louvers, ducts, or shafts may be required for indoor package units.

Water-Side Economizer

The water-side economizer is another option for reducing energy use. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 addresses its application, as do some state energy codes. The water-side economizer consists of a water coil in a self-contained unit upstream of the direct-expansion cooling coil. All economizer control valves, piping between economizer coil and condenser, and economizer control wiring can be factory installed. This applies typically for indoor packaged compressor units using a water loop for heat rejection.

The water-side economizer uses the low cooling tower or evaporative condenser water temperature to either (1) precool entering air, (2) assist mechanical cooling, or (3) provide total system cooling if the cooling water is cold enough. If the economizer is unable to maintain the air-handling unit's supply air or zone set point, factory-mounted controls integrate economizer and compressor operation to meet cooling requirements. For constant condenser water flow control using a economizer energy recovery coil and the unit condenser, two control valves are factory-wired for complementary control, with one valve driven open while the other is driven closed. This keeps water flow through the condenser relatively constant. In variable-flow control, condenser water flow varies during unit operation. The valve in bypass/energy recovery loop is an on/off valve and is closed when the economizer is enabled. Water flow through the economizer coil is modulated by its automatic control valve, allowing variable cooling water flow as cooling load increases (valve opens) and reduced flow on a decrease in cooling demand. If the economizer is unable to satisfy the cooling requirements, factory-mounted controls integrate economizer and compressor operation. In this operating mode, the economizer valve is fully open. When the self-contained unit is not in cooling mode, both valves are closed. Reducing or eliminating cooling water flow reduces pumping energy.

Advantages

- Compressor energy is reduced by precooling entering air. Often, building load can be completely satisfied with an entering condenser water temperature of less than 13°C. Because the wet-bulb temperature is always less than or equal to the dry-bulb temperature, a lower discharge air temperature is often available.
- Building humidification does not affect indoor humidity by introducing outdoor air.
- No external wall penetration is required for exhaust or outdoor air ducts.
- Controls are less complex than for air-side economizers, because they are often inside the packaged unit.
- The coil can be mechanically cleaned.
- More net usable floor area is available because large outdoor and relief air ducts are unnecessary.

Disadvantages

- Cooling tower water treatment cost is greater.
- Cooling tower water usage is greater due to blowdown requirements.
- Air-side pressure drop may increase with the constant added resistance of an economizer coil in the air stream.
- Condenser water pump pressure may increase slightly.
- The cooling tower must be designed for winter operation (see Chapter 40).
- The increased operation (including in winter) required of the cooling tower may reduce its life.

3. WINDOW-MOUNTED AND THROUGH-THE-WALL ROOM HVAC UNITS

Window air conditioners (air-cooled room conditioners) and through-the-wall room air conditioners with supplemental heating are designed to cool or heat individual room spaces. Window units are used where low initial cost, quick installation, and other operating or performance criteria outweigh the advantages of more sophisticated systems. Room units are also available in through-the-wall sleeve mountings. Sleeve-installed units are popular in low-cost apartments, motels, and homes. Ventilation can be through operable windows or limited outdoor air ventilation introduced through the self-contained room HVAC unit. These units are described in more detail in Chapter 49.

Window units may be used as auxiliaries to a central heating or cooling system or to condition selected spaces when the central system is shut down. These units usually serve only part of the spaces conditioned by the basic system. Both the basic system and window units should be sized to cool the space adequately without the other operating.

A through-the-wall air-cooled room air conditioner is designed to cool or heat individual room spaces. Design and manufacturing parameters vary widely. Specifications range from appliance grade through heavy-duty commercial grade, the latter known as packaged terminal air conditioners (PTACs) or packaged terminal heat pumps (PTHPs) (AHRI *Standard* 310/380). With proper maintenance, manufacturers project an equipment life of 10 to 15 years for these units.

More sophisticated through-the-wall units are available for school applications to replace heat-only unit ventilators with heating and cooling unit ventilators. These applications may have steam or hot-water coils incorporated. Typically, packaged control systems provide control of outdoor ventilation, economizer, or compressor operation as required.

Advantages

- Lowest first cost HVAC system.
- Installation of in-room unit is simple. It usually only requires an opening in the wall or displacement of a window to mount the unit, and connection to electrical power.
- Equipment is often available from stock.
- Generally, the system is well-suited to spaces requiring many zones of individual temperature control.
- Designers can specify electric, hydronic, or steam heat or use an air-to-air heat pump design.
- Service of in-room equipment can be quickly restored by replacing a defective chassis.
- Ductwork or air distribution systems are not required.

Disadvantages

- Equipment life may be less than for large central equipment, typically 10 to 15 years, and units are built to appliance standards, rather than building equipment standards.
- Energy use may be relatively high.
- Direct access to outdoor air is needed for condenser heat rejection; thus, these units cannot be used for interior rooms.
- The louver and wall box must stop wind-driven rain from collecting in the wall box and leaking into the building.

- The wall box should drain to the outdoor, which may cause dripping on walls, balconies, or sidewalks.
- Temperature control is usually two-position, which causes swings in room temperature.
- Ventilation capabilities are fixed by equipment design.
- Economizer is limited.
- Humidification, when required, must be provided by separate equipment.
- Noise and vibration levels vary considerably and are not generally suitable for sound-critical applications.
- Routine maintenance of a large number of units is required to maintain capacity. Condenser and cooling coils must be cleaned, and filters must be changed regularly.
- Discharge air location limited to unit location.

Design Considerations

A through-the-wall or window-mounted air-conditioning unit incorporates a complete air-cooled refrigeration and air-handling system in an individual package. Each room is an individual occupant-controlled zone. Cooled or warmed air is discharged in response to thermostatic control to meet room requirements (see the discussion on controls following in this section).

Each PTAC or PTHP has a self-contained, air-cooled direct-expansion or heat pump cooling system; a heating system (electric, hot water, steam, and/or a heat pump cycle); and controls. See Figure 3 in Chapter 49 for unit configuration.

A through-the-wall air conditioner or heat pump system is installed in buildings requiring many temperature control zones such as office buildings, motels and hotels, apartments and dormitories, schools and other education buildings, and areas of nursing homes or hospitals where air recirculation is allowed.

These units can be used for renovation of existing buildings, because existing heating systems can still be used. The equipment can be used in both low- and high-rise buildings. In buildings where a stack effect is present, use should be limited to areas that have dependable ventilation and a tight wall of separation between the interior and exterior.

Room air conditioners are often used in parts of buildings primarily conditioned by other systems, especially where spaces to be conditioned are (1) physically isolated from the rest of the building and (2) occupied on a different time schedule (e.g., clergy offices in a church, ticket offices in a theater).

Ventilation air through each terminal may be inadequate in many situations, particularly in high-rise structures because of the stack effect. Chapter 16 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* explains combined wind and stack effects. Electrically operated outdoor air dampers, which close automatically when the equipment is stopped, can reduce heat losses in winter.

Refrigeration Equipment. Room air conditioners are generally supplied with hermetic reciprocating or scroll compressors. Capillary tubes are used in place of expansion valves in most units.

Some room air conditioners have only one motor to drive both the evaporator and condenser fans. The unit circulates air through the condenser coil whenever the evaporator fan is running, even during the heating season. Annual energy consumption of a unit with a single motor is generally higher than one with a separate motor, even when the energy efficiency ratio (EER) or the coefficient of performance (COP) is the same for both. Year-round, continuous flow of air through the condenser increases dirt accumulation on the coil and other components, which increases maintenance costs and reduces equipment life.

Because through-the-wall conditioners are seldom installed with drains, they require a positive and reliable means of condensate disposal. Conditioners are available that spray condensate in a fine mist over the condenser coil. These units dispose of more condensate than can be developed without any drip, splash, or spray. In heat pumps, provision must be made for disposal of condensate generated from the outdoor coil during defrost.

Many air-cooled room conditioners experience evaporator icing and become ineffective when outdoor temperatures fall below about 18°C. Units that ice at a lower outdoor temperature may be required to handle the added load created by high lighting levels and high solar radiation found in contemporary buildings.

Heating Equipment. The air-to-air heat pump cycle described in Chapter 48 is available in through-the-wall room air conditioners. Application considerations are similar to conventional units without the heat pump cycle, which is used for space heating when the outdoor temperature is above 2 to 5°C.

The prime advantage of the heat pump cycle is that it reduces annual energy consumption for heating. Savings in heat energy over conventional electric heating ranges from 10 to 60%, depending on the climate.

In some applications, when steam or hot water heat is used, designers should consider piping isolation to allow removal of the units' chassis for service and repair.

Electric resistance elements supply heating below this level and during defrost cycles.

Controls. All controls for through-the-wall air conditioners are included as a part of the conditioner. The following control configurations are available:

- **Thermostat control** is either unit-mounted or remote wall-mounted.
- **Motel and hotel guest room controls** allow starting and stopping units from a central point.
- **Occupied/unoccupied controls** (for occupancies of less than 24 h) start and stop the equipment at preset times with a time clock. Conditioners operate normally with the unit thermostat until the preset cutoff time. After this point, each conditioner has its own reset control, which allows the occupant of the conditioned space to reset the conditioner for either cooling or heating, as required.
- **Master/slave control** is used when multiple conditioners are operated by the same thermostat.
- **Emergency standby control** allows a conditioner to operate during an emergency, such as a power failure, so that the room-side blowers can operate to provide heating. Units must be specially wired to allow operation on emergency generator circuits.
- **BACnet™ integration** is generally available for multiple installations to improve automation (see ASHRAE *Standard* 135). A building automation system (BAS) allows more sophisticated unit control by time-of-day scheduling, optimal start/stop, duty cycling, demand limiting, custom programming, etc. This control can keep units operating at peak efficiency by alerting the operator to conditions that could cause substandard performance.

When several units are used in a single space, controls should be interlocked to prevent simultaneous heating and cooling. In commercial applications (e.g., motels), centrally operated switches can de-energize units in unoccupied rooms.

4. WATER-SOURCE HEAT PUMP SYSTEMS

Water-source heat pump systems use multiple cooling/heating units distributed throughout the building. For more in-depth discussion of water-source heat pumps, see Chapters 9 and 48. Outdoor air ventilation requires either direct or indirect supply air from an additional air-handling system.

Designed to cool and heat individual rooms or multiple spaces grouped together by zone, water-source heat pumps may be installed along the perimeter with a combination of horizontal and vertical condenser water piping distribution, or stacked vertically with condenser water piping also stacked vertically to minimize

equipment space effects on the rooms they serve. They can also be ceiling mounted or concealed above the ceiling with duct distribution to the area served.

Water-source heat pump systems can transfer energy within the system by using the common water loop. Units on sunny exposures in cooling mode add heat to the water loop, from which units in heating modes can draw heat. Water-source heat pump systems also require further decentralized equipment that includes a source of heat rejection such as a cooling tower or groundwater installation. A water distribution piping system with pumps is required. A supplemental heating source such as a boiler may be required, depending on the installation's location (e.g., in colder winter climates). Data on condenser water systems and the necessary heat rejection equipment can be found in Chapters 14 and 40.

Advantages

- Water-source heat pump systems use renewable energy when designed with a ground source.
- Unit installation is simple for both vertical and horizontal installation and for concealed locations.
- Units are available in multiple electrical configurations.
- Water-source heat pumps can be installed with a lift to rig horizontal units at or above a ceiling.
- Generally, the system is well suited to spaces requiring many zones of individual temperature control.
- Units are available in multiple sizes, typically in 1.8 kW increments, to meet any need.
- Designers can specify energy recovery for ventilation air separately.
- Units can be individually metered easily.
- Units are easily relocated if space is remodeled.

Disadvantages

- Outdoor air introduction to the building must be separately designed.
- Condensate drain piping installation and routine maintenance can be a problem, particularly for units installed above ceilings.
- Economizer systems typically do not apply.
- Humidification, when required, must be provided by separate equipment.
- Discharge heating air temperatures are lower compared to gas heat.
- Noise and vibration levels vary considerably and are not generally suitable for sound-critical applications.
- Routine maintenance within occupied space is required to maintain capacity.

Design Considerations

The location for the central heat rejection and/or heat gain equipment requires consideration. If a cooling tower is used, designers may consider separating the indoor water loop from the outdoor water loop with a heat exchanger. Pump systems can be variable flow when units are provided with automatic flow valves integrated to open with compressor operation.

Units are usually furnished with communicating digital controls. Units are typically provided with occupied/unoccupied sequence.

These units can be used for renovation of existing buildings where limited ceiling space would prevent other types of HVAC systems (e.g., all-air systems) from being installed. The equipment can be used in both low- and high-rise buildings; both applications require some form of outdoor ventilation to serve the occupants.

See Chapters 9 and 48 for data on refrigeration cycle, heating cycle, automatic controls, and other information on design and operation and maintenance.

5. MULTIPLE-UNIT SYSTEMS

Multiple-unit systems generally use under 70 kW, single-zone unitary HVAC equipment with a unit for each zone (Figure 1). These units typically have factory-charged, indoor compressor refrigeration systems. Some use remote air-cooled condensers with field-provided refrigeration piping. Equipment can be packaged air cooled, and wall louvers can be used to reject condenser heat to the outdoors. Zoning is determined by (1) cooling and heating loads, (2) occupancy, (3) flexibility requirements, (4) appearance, and (5) equipment and duct space availability. Multiple-unit systems are popular for low-rise office buildings, manufacturing plants, shopping centers, department stores, and apartment buildings. Unitary self-contained units are excellent for renovation.

The system configuration can be horizontal distribution of equipment and associated ductwork and piping, or vertical distribution of equipment and piping with horizontal distribution of ductwork. Outdoor air ventilation requires either direct or indirect supply air from an additional air-handling system.

Heating media may be steam or hot water piped to the individual units or electric heat at the unit and/or at individual air terminals that provide multiple-space temperature-controlled zones. Heat pumps are available in some equipment. Cooling media may be refrigerant/direct expansion (DX) air, or condenser water piped to individual units. A typical system features zone-by-zone equipment with a central cooling tower and boiler, although electric heat and DX refrigerant cooling may be used. When these units are cooled by DX coils connected to a variable-refrigerant-flow (VRF) system, the system can take on more "centralized" characteristics; see Chapter 18.

Supply air is typically constant volume; outdoor ventilation is typically a fixed minimum. Some designs can include variable volume based on bypass volume control. Usually, multiple units do not come with a return air fan; the supply fan must overcome return air and supply air duct static resistance. Air-side economizers are rare; a water-side economizer is sometimes more practical where condenser water is used, and may be required by state code.

Multiple-unit systems require a localized equipment room where one or more units can be installed. This arrangement takes up floor space, but allows equipment maintenance to occur out of the building's occupied areas, minimizing interruptions to occupants.

Advantages

- The system can be applied to both large or small buildings (building height).

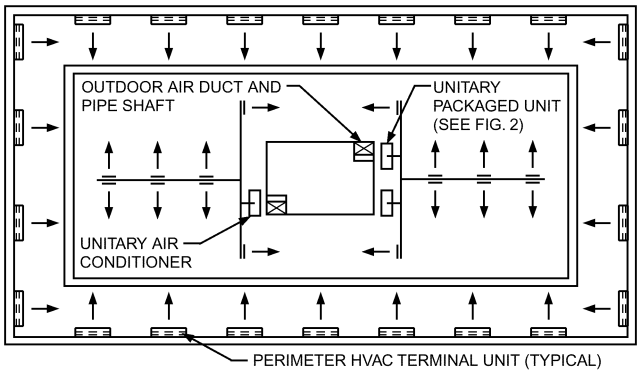

Fig. 1 Multiple-Unit Systems: Single-Zone Unitary HVAC Equipment for Interior and Packaged Terminal Air Conditioners (PTACs) for Perimeter

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

- Installation is simple. Equipment is readily available in sizes that allow easy handling.
- Installation of outdoor heat pumps is simple with rigging onto concrete pad at grade level or on the roof.
- Equipment and components can be standardized.
- Relocation of units to other spaces or buildings is practical, if necessary.
- Energy efficiency can be quite good, particularly where climate or building use results in a balance of heating and cooling zones.
- Units are available with complete, self-contained control systems that include variable-volume control, night setback, and morning warm-up.
- Equipment is out of the occupied space, making the system quieter than water-source heat pumps.
- Easy access to equipment facilitates routine maintenance.
- Failure of one unit affects only a limited area.
- System is repetitive and simple, facilitating operator training.
- Tenant utility metering is easier than with other systems.

Disadvantages

- Access to outdoor air must be provided at each location.
- Fans may have limited static pressure ratings.
- Air filtration options are limited.
- Discharge air temperature varies with on/off or step control.
- Humidification can be impractical on a unit-by-unit basis and may need to be provided by a separate system.
- Integral air-cooled condensing units for some direct-expansion cooling installations should be located outdoors within a limited distance.
- Multiple units and equipment closets or rooms may occupy rentable floor space.
- Multiple pieces of equipment may increase maintenance requirements.
- Redundant equipment or easy replacement may not be practical.

Design Considerations

Unitary systems can be used throughout a building or to supplement perimeter packaged terminal units (Figures 1 and 2). Because core areas frequently have little or no heat loss, unitary equipment with air- or water-cooled condensers can be applied. The equipment can be used in both low- and high-rise buildings; both applications require some form of outdoor ventilation to serve the occupants.

Typical application may be an interior work area, computer room, or other space requiring continual cooling. Special-purpose unitary equipment is frequently used to cool, dehumidify, humidify, and reheat to maintain close control of space temperature and humidity in computer areas (Figure 2). For more information, see Chapters 19 and 20 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, as well as Chapters 48 and 49 of this volume.

In the multiple-unit system shown in Figure 3, one unit may be used to precondition outdoor air for a group of units. This all-outdoor-air unit prevents hot, humid air from entering the conditioned space during periods of light load. The outdoor unit should have sufficient capacity to cool the required ventilation air from outside design conditions to interior design dew point. Zone units are then sized to handle only the internal load for their particular area.

Units are typically under 70 kW of cooling and are typically constant-volume units. VAV distribution may be accomplished on these units with a bypass damper that allows excess supply air to bypass to the return air duct. The bypass damper ensures constant airflow across the direct-expansion cooling coil to avoid coil freeze-up caused by low airflow. The damper is usually controlled by supply duct pressure. Variable-frequency drives can also be used.

Controls. Units are usually furnished with individual electric controls, but can be enhanced to a more comprehensive building management system.

Economizer Cycle. When outdoor temperature allows, energy use can be reduced by cooling with outdoor air in lieu of mechanical refrigeration. Units must be located close to an outdoor wall or outdoor air duct shafts. Where this is not possible, it may be practical to add a water-side economizer cooling coil, with cold water obtained by sending condenser water through a winterized cooling tower. Chapter 40 has further details. Economizer cycle may be required by state code.

Acoustics and Vibration. Because these units are typically located near occupied space, they can affect acoustics. The designer must study both the airflow breakout path and the unit's radiated sound power when coordinating selection of wall and ceiling construction surrounding the unit. Locating units over noncritical work spaces such as restrooms or storage areas around the equipment room helps reduce noise in occupied space. Chapter 49 of the 2023

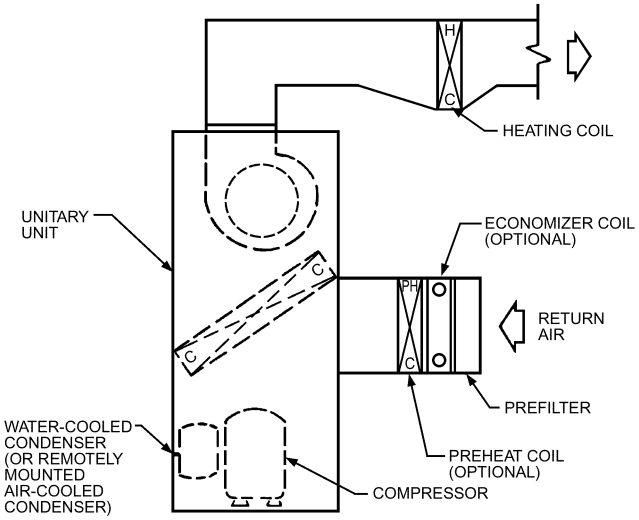

Fig. 2 Vertical Self-Contained Unit

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

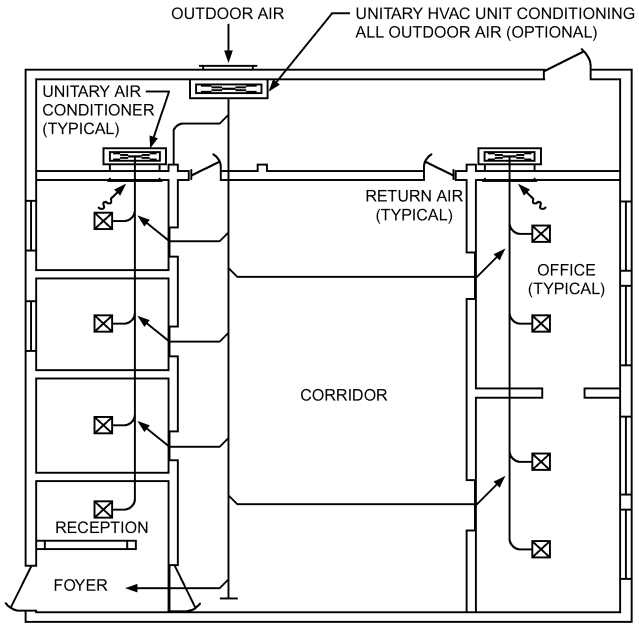

Fig. 3 Dedicated Outdoor-Air-Conditioning Unit

ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications has more information on HVAC-related sound and vibration concerns.

6. RESIDENTIAL AND LIGHT COMMERCIAL SPLIT SYSTEMS

These systems distribute cooling and heating equipment throughout the building. A split system consists of an indoor unit with air distribution and temperature control, with either a remote air-cooled condenser or remote air-cooled condensing unit. These units are commonly used in single-story or low-rise buildings, and in residential applications where condenser water is not readily available. Commercial split systems are well suited to small projects with variable occupancy schedules.

Indoor equipment is generally installed in service areas adjacent to the conditioned space. When a single unit is required, the indoor unit and its related ductwork constitute a central air system, as described in Chapter 4.

Typical components of a split-system air conditioner include an indoor unit with evaporator coils, heating coils, filters, valves, and a condensing unit with the compressors and condenser coils.

The configuration can be horizontal distribution of equipment and associated ductwork and piping, or vertical distribution of equipment and piping with horizontal distribution of ductwork. These applications share some of the advantages of multiple-unit systems, but may only have one system installation per project. Outdoor air ventilation requires either direct or indirect supply from another source (e.g., operable window).

Heating is usually electric or gas, but may be steam, hot water, or possibly oil-fired at the unit. Cooling is usually by direct expansion. Heat pump operation is readily accommodated.

Supply air may be constant- or variable-volume bypass damper control; outdoor ventilation is usually a fixed minimum or barometric relief economizer cycle. A supplemental exhaust fan may be required to complete the design.

Air-cooled heat pumps located on roofs or adjacent to buildings are another type of package equipment with most of the features noted here, with the additional benefit of supply air distribution and equipment outside the occupied space. This improved ductwork arrangement makes equipment accessible for servicing out the occupied space, unlike in-room units. See Chapter 48 for additional design, operating, and constructability discussion.

Advantages

- Low first cost.
- Unitary split-system units allow air-handling equipment to be placed close to the heating and cooling load, which allows ample air distribution to the conditioned space with minimum ductwork and fan power.
- Tenant utility metering is easy.
- Heat rejection through a remote air-cooled condenser allows the final heat rejector (and its associated noise) to be remote from the air-conditioned space.
- A floor-by-floor arrangement can reduce fan power consumption because air handlers are located close to the conditioned space.
- Equipment is generally located in the building interior near elevators and other service areas and does not interfere with the building perimeter.

Disadvantages

- Multiple units and equipment closet may occupy rentable floor space.
- The proximity of the air handler to the conditioned space requires special attention to unit inlet and outlet airflow and to building acoustics around the unit.
- Multiple pieces of equipment may increase maintenance requirements.
- Ducting ventilation air to the unit and removing condensate from the cooling coil should be considered.
- Refrigeration piping to outdoors has limited length (typically about 30 m).
- A unit that uses an air-side economizer must be located near an outer wall or outdoor air shaft. Split-system units do not generally include return air fans.
- A separate method of handling and controlling relief air may be required.
- Filter options and special features may be limited.
- Discharge temperature varies because of on/off or step control.
- Gas-heat furnace needs access for flue venting to roof or outdoors.

Design Considerations

Characteristics that favor split systems are their low first cost, simplicity of installation, and simplicity of training required for operation. Servicing is also relatively inexpensive.

The modest space requirements of split-system equipment make it excellent for renovations or for spot cooling a single zone. Control is usually one- or two-step cooling and one- or two-step or modulating heat. VAV operation is possible with a supply air bypass. Some commercial units can modulate airflow, with additional cooling modulation using hot-gas bypass.

Commercial split-system units are available as constant-volume equipment for use in atriums, public areas, and industrial applications. Basic temperature controls include a room-mounted or return-air-mounted thermostat that cycles the compressor(s) as needed. Upgrades include fan modulation and VAV control. When applied with VAV terminals, commercial split systems provide excellent comfort and individual zone control.

7. COMMERCIAL SELF-CONTAINED (FLOOR-BY-FLOOR) SYSTEMS

Commercial self-contained (floor-by-floor) systems are a type of multiple-unit, decentralized cooling and heating system. Equipment is usually configured vertically, but may be horizontal. Supply air distribution may be a discharge air plenum, raised-floor supply air plenum (air displacement), or horizontal duct distribution, installed on a floor-by-floor basis. Outdoor air ventilation requires either direct or indirect supply air from an additional air-handling system.

Typical components include compressors, water-cooled condensers, evaporator coils, economizer coils, heating coils, filters, valves, and controls (Figure 4). To complete the system, a building needs cooling towers and condenser water pumps. See Chapter 40 for more information on cooling towers.

Advantages

- This equipment integrates refrigeration, heating, air handling, and controls into a factory package, thus eliminating many field integration problems.
- Units are well suited for office environments with variable occupancy schedules.
- Floor-by-floor arrangement can reduce fan power consumption.
- Large vertical duct shafts and fire dampers are eliminated.
- Electrical wiring, condenser water piping, and condensate removal are centrally located.
- Equipment is generally located in the building interior near elevators and other service areas, and does not interfere with the building perimeter.
- Integral water-side economizer coils and controls are available, which allow interior equipment location and eliminate large outdoor air and exhaust ducts and relief fans.
- An acoustical discharge plenum is available, which allows lower fan power and lower sound power levels.

Disadvantages

- Units must be located near an outdoor wall or outdoor air shaft to incorporate an air-side economizer.
- A separate relief air system and controls must be incorporated if an air-side economizer is used.
- Close proximity to building occupants requires careful analysis of space acoustics.
- Filter options may be limited.
- Discharge temperature varies because of on/off or step control.

Design Considerations

Commercial self-contained units have criteria similar to those for multiple and light commercial units, and can serve either VAV or constant-volume systems. These units contain one or two fans inside the cabinet. The fans are commonly configured in a draw-through arrangement.

The size and diversity of the zones served often dictate which system is optimal. For comfort applications, self-contained VAV units coupled with terminal boxes or fan-powered terminal boxes are popular for their energy savings, individual zone control, and acoustic benefits. Constant-volume self-contained units have low installation cost and are often used in noncomfort or industrial air-conditioning applications or in single-zone comfort applications.

Unit airflow is reduced in response to terminal boxes closing. Common methods used to modulate airflow delivered by the fan to match system requirements include fan speed control and multiple-speed fan motors.

Appropriate outdoor air and exhaust fans and dampers work in conjunction with the self-contained unit. Their operation must be coordinated with unit operation to maintain design air exchange and building pressurization.

Refrigeration Equipment. Commercial self-contained units usually feature reciprocating or scroll compressors, although screw compressors are available in some equipment. Thermostatic or electronic expansion valves are used. Condensers are water cooled and usually reject heat to a common condenser-water system serving multiple units. A separate cooling tower or other final heat rejection device is required.

Self-contained units may control capacity with multiple compressors. For VAV systems, compressors are turned on or off or unloaded to maintain discharge air temperature. Hot-gas bypass is often incorporated to provide additional capacity control. As system airflow decreases, the temperature of air leaving the unit is often reset upward so that a minimum ventilation rate can be maintained. Resetting the discharge air temperature limits the unit's demand, thus saving energy. However, increased air temperature and volume increase fan energy.

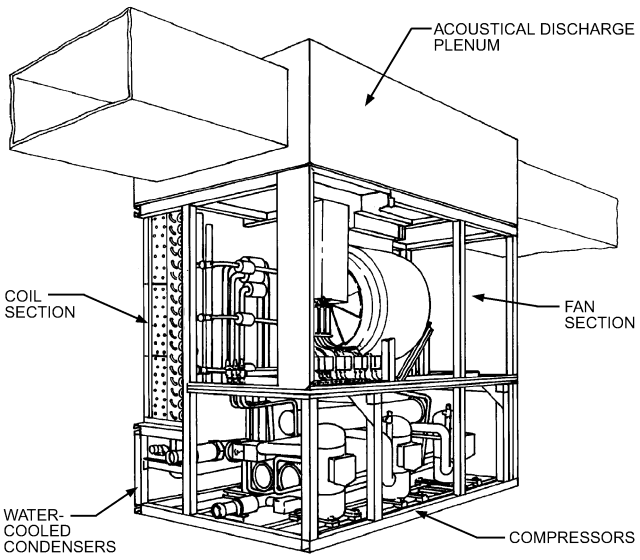

Fig. 4 Commercial Self-Contained Unit with Discharge Plenum

Heating Equipment. In many applications, heating is done by perimeter radiation, with heating installed in the terminal boxes or other such systems when floor-by-floor units are used. If heating is incorporated in these units (e.g., preheat or morning warm-up), it is usually provided by hot-water coils or electric resistance heat, but could be by a gas- or oil-fired heat exchanger.

Controls. Self-contained units typically have built-in capacity controls for refrigeration, economizers, and fans. Although units under 50 kW of cooling tend to have basic on/off/automatic controls, many larger systems have sophisticated microprocessor controls that monitor and take action based on local or remote programming. These controls provide for stand-alone operation, or they can be tied to a building automation system (BAS).

A BAS allows more sophisticated unit control by time-of-day scheduling, optimal start/stop, duty cycling, demand limiting, custom programming, etc. This control can keep units operating at peak efficiency by alerting the operator to conditions that could cause substandard performance.

The unit's control panel can sequence the modulating valves and dampers of an economizer. A water-side economizer is located upstream of the evaporator coil, and when condenser water temperature is lower than entering air temperature to the unit, water flow is directed through the economizer coil to either partially or fully meet building load. If the coil alone cannot meet design requirements, but the entering condenser water temperature remains cool enough to provide some useful precooling, the control panel can keep the economizer coil active as stages of compressors are activated. When entering condenser water exceeds entering air temperature to the unit, the coil is valved off, and water is circulated through the unit's condensers only.

Typically, in an air-side economizer, an enthalpy or dry-bulb temperature switch energizes the unit to bring in outdoor air as the first stage of cooling. An outdoor air damper modulates flow to meet design temperature, and when outdoor air can no longer provide sufficient cooling, compressors are energized.

A temperature input to the control panel, either from a discharge air sensor or a zone sensor, provides information for integrated economizer and compressor control. Supply air temperature reset is commonly applied to VAV systems.

In addition to capacity controls, units have safety features for the refrigerant-side, air-side, and electrical systems. Refrigeration protection controls typically consist of high and low refrigerant pressure sensors and temperature sensors wired into a common control panel. The controller then cycles compressors on and off or activates hot-gas bypass to meet system requirements.

Constant-volume units typically have high-pressure cut-out controls, which protect the unit and ductwork from high static pressure. VAV units typically have some type of static pressure probe inserted in the discharge duct downstream of the unit. As terminal boxes close, the control modulates airflow to meet the set point, which is determined by calculating the static pressure required to deliver design airflow to the zone farthest from the unit.

Acoustics and Vibration. Because self-contained units are typically located near occupied space, their performance can significantly affect occupant comfort. Units of less than 50 kW of cooling are often placed inside a closet, with a discharge grille penetrating the common wall to the occupied space. Larger units have their own equipment room and duct system. Common sound paths to consider include the following:

- Fan inlet and compressor sound radiates through the unit casing to enter the space through the separating wall.
- Fan discharge sound is airborne through the supply duct and enters the space through duct breakout and diffusers.
- Airborne fan inlet sound enters the space through the return air ducts, or ceiling plenum if unducted.

Air is often discharged from the self-contained unit with a plenum on top of the unit. This plenum facilitates multiple duct discharges that reduce the amount of airflow over a single occupied space adjacent to the equipment room (see Figure 4). Reducing airflow in one direction reduces the sound that breaks out from the discharge duct. About a metre of internally lined round duct immediately off the discharge plenum may significantly reduce noise levels in adjacent areas.

In addition to the airflow breakout path, the system designer must study unit-radiated sound power when determining equipment room wall and door construction. A unit's air-side inlet typically has the highest radiated sound. The inlet space and return air ducts should be located away from the critical area to reduce the effect of this sound path.

Selecting a fan that operates near its peak efficiency point helps design quiet systems. Fans are typically dominant in the first three octave bands, and selections at high static pressures or near the fan's surge region should be avoided.

Units may be isolated from the structure with neoprene pads or spring isolators. Manufacturers often isolate the fan and compressors internally, which generally reduces external isolation requirements.

8. COMMERCIAL OUTDOOR PACKAGED SYSTEMS

Commercial outdoor packaged systems are available in sizes from 7 kW to over 700 kW. There are multiple choices of rooftop and/or horizontal grade-mounted configurations to meet building needs.

Heating is usually electric or gas but may be steam, hot water, or possibly oil-fired at the unit. Cooling is usually by direct expansion, but could be chilled water.

Supply air distribution can be for multiple floors by vertical duct shafts or horizontal duct distribution installed on a floor-by-floor basis. Outdoor air ventilation can be provided by barometric relief, fan-powered relief, or return air/exhaust air fan.

Equipment is generally mounted on the roof (rooftop units [RTUs]), but can also be mounted at grade level. RTUs are designed as central-station equipment for single-zone, multizone, and VAV applications.

Systems are available in several levels of design sophistication, from simple factory-standard light commercial packaged equipment, to double-wall commercial packaged equipment with upgraded features, up to fully customized industrial-quality packages. Often, factory-standard commercial rooftop unit(s) are satisfactory for small and medium-sized office buildings. On large projects and highly demanding systems, the additional cost of a custom packaged unit can be justified by life-cycle cost analyses. Custom systems offer great flexibility and can be configured to satisfy almost any requirement. Special features such as heat recovery, service vestibules, boilers, chillers, and space for other mechanical equipment can be designed into the unit.

For additional information, see Chapter 48.

Advantages

- Equipment location allows easy service access without maintenance staff entering or disturbing occupied space.
- Construction costs are offset toward the end of the project because the unit can be one of the last items installed.
- Installation is simplified and field labor costs are reduced because most components are assembled and tested in a controlled factory environment.
- A single source has responsibility for design and operation of all major mechanical systems in the building.
- Valuable building space for mechanical equipment is conserved.
- It is suitable for floor-by-floor control in low-rise office buildings.
- Outdoor air is readily available for ventilation and economy cycle use.
- Combustion air intake and flue gas exhaust are facilitated if natural gas heat is used.
- Upgraded design features, such as high-efficiency filtration or heat recovery devices, are available from some manufacturers.

Disadvantages

- Maintaining or servicing outdoor units is sometimes difficult, especially in inclement weather.
- With all rooftop equipment, safe access to the equipment is a concern. Even slightly sloped roofs are a potential hazard.
- Frequent removal of panels for access may destroy the unit's weatherproofing, causing electrical component failure, rusting, and water leakage.
- Rooftop unit design must be coordinated with structural design because it may represent a significant building structural load.
- In cold climates, provision must be made to keep snow from blocking air intakes and access doors, and the potential for freezing of hydronic heating or steam humidification components must be considered.
- Casing corrosion is a potential problem. Many manufacturers prevent rusting with galvanized or vinyl coatings and other protective measures.
- Outdoor installation can reduce equipment life.
- Depending on building construction, sound levels and transmitted vibration may be excessive.
- Architectural considerations may limit allowable locations or require special screening to minimize visual effect.

Design Considerations

Centering the rooftop unit over the conditioned space reduces fan power, ducting, and wiring. Avoid installation directly above spaces where noise and vibration level is critical.

All outdoor ductwork should be insulated, if not already required by associated energy codes. In addition, ductwork should be (1) sealed to prevent condensation in insulation during the heating season and (2) weatherproofed to keep it from getting wet.

Use multiple single-zone, not multizone, units where feasible to simplify installation and improve energy consumption. For large areas (e.g., manufacturing plants, warehouses, gymnasiums), single-zone units are less expensive and provide protection against total system failure.

Use units with return air fans whenever return air static pressure loss exceeds 125 Pa or the unit introduces a large percentage of outdoor air via an economizer.

Units are also available with relief fans for use with an economizer in lieu of continuously running a return fan. Relief fans can be initiated by static pressure control.

In a rooftop application, the air handler is outdoors and needs to be weatherproofed against rain, snow, and, in some areas, sand. In coastal environments, enclosure materials' resistance (e.g., to salt spray) must also be considered. In cold climates, fuel oil does not atomize and must be warmed to burn properly. Hot-water or steam heating coils and piping must be protected against freezing. In some areas, enclosures are needed to maintain units effectively during inclement weather. A permanent safe access to the roof, as well as a roof walkway to protect against roof damage, are essential.

Rooftop units are generally mounted using (1) integral frames or (2) light steel structures. Integral support frames are designed by the manufacturer to connect to the base of the unit. Separate openings for supply and return ducts are not required. The completed installation must adequately drain condensed water. Light steel structures allow the unit to be installed above the roof using separate, flashed duct openings. Any condensed water can be drained through the roof drains.

Accessories such as economizers, special filters, and humidifiers are available. Factory-installed and wired economizer packages are also available. Other options offered are return and exhaust fans, variable-volume controls with hot-gas bypass or other form of coil frost protection, smoke and fire detectors, portable external service enclosures, special filters, and microprocessor-based controls with various control options, including BACnet™ integration.

For projects with custom-designed equipment, it may be desirable to require additional witnessed factory testing to ensure performance and quality of the final product.

Refrigeration Equipment. Large systems incorporate reciprocating, screw, or scroll compressors. Chapter 38 has information about compressors and Chapters 43 and 48 discuss refrigeration equipment, including the general size ranges of available equipment. Air-cooled or evaporative condensers are built integral to the equipment.

Air-cooled condensers pass outdoor air over a dry coil to condense the refrigerant. This results in a higher condensing temperature and, thus, a larger power input at peak conditions. However, this peak time may be relatively short over 24 h. The air-cooled condenser is popular in small reciprocating systems because of its low maintenance requirements.

Evaporative condensers pass air over coils sprayed with water, using adiabatic saturation to lower the condensing temperature. As with the cooling tower, freeze prevention and close control of water treatment are required for successful operation. The lower power consumption of the refrigeration system and the much smaller footprint from using an evaporative versus air-cooled condenser are gained at the expense of the cost of water used and increased maintenance costs.

Heating Equipment. Natural-gas, propane, oil, electricity, hot-water, steam, and refrigerant gas heating options are available. These are normally incorporated directly into the air-handling sections. Custom equipment can also be designed with a separate prepiped boiler and circulating system.

Controls. Multiple lower-capacity outdoor units are usually single-zone, constant-volume, or potentially VAV if units are larger capacity. Zoning for temperature control determines the number of units; each zone has a unit. Zones are determined by the cooling and heating loads for the space served, occupancy, allowable roof loads, flexibility requirements, appearance, duct size limitations, and equipment size availability. These units can also serve core areas of buildings, with perimeter spaces served by PTACs.

Most operating and safety controls are provided by the equipment manufacturer. Although remote monitoring panels are optional, they are recommended to allow operating personnel to monitor performance.

Acoustics and Vibration. Most unitary equipment is available with limited separate vibration isolation of rotating equipment. Custom equipment is available with several (optional) degrees of internal vibration isolation. Isolation of the entire unit casing is rarely required; however, use care when mounting on light structures. If external isolation is required, it should be coordinated with the unit manufacturer to ensure proper separation of internal versus external isolation deflection.

Outdoor noise from unitary equipment should be reduced to a minimum. Evaluate sound power levels at all property lines. Indoor-radiated noise from the unit's fans, compressors, and condensers travels directly through the roof into occupied space below. Mitigation usually involves adding mass, such as two layers of gypsum board, inside the roof curb beneath the unit. Airborne duct discharge noise, primarily from the fans themselves, can be attenuated by silencers in the supply and return air ducts or by acoustically lined ductwork.

9. SINGLE-ZONE VAV SYSTEMS

These systems distribute cooling and heating to a single zone by supplying constant-temperature airflow at varying volumes. A variable-speed fan controls the quantity of air provided to the space by modulating the fan speed based on space load. The compressor modulates based on the temperature of the supply air leaving the unit to determine the amount of refrigerant flow needed to maintain the supply air set point. Heating is usually electric with silicon controlled rectifier (SCR) control or modulating gas-fired stainless steel heat exchangers.

Advantages

- Equipment location allows easy service access without maintenance staff entering or disturbing occupied space.
- Installation is simple and equipment is readily available in sizes for easy handling.
- Installation is simplified and field labor costs are reduced because most components are assembled and tested in a controlled factory environment.
- Units are available with complete VAV controls including night setback and morning warm-up.
- Valuable building space for mechanical equipment is conserved.
- It is suitable for floor-by-floor control in low-rise office buildings.
- Outdoor air is readily available for ventilation and economizer cycle use.
- Combustion air intake and flue gas exhaust are facilitated if natural gas heat is used.
- Tenant utility metering is easier.
- Failure of one systems affects a limited area.

Disadvantages

- Maintaining or servicing outdoor units is sometimes difficult, especially in inclement weather.
- Air filtration options are limited.
- With all rooftop equipment, safe access to the equipment is a concern. Even slightly sloped roofs are a potential hazard.
- Frequent removal of panels for access may destroy the unit's weatherproofing, causing electrical component failure, rusting, and water leakage.
- Rooftop unit design must be coordinated with structural design because it may represent a significant building structural load.
- In cold climates, provision must be made to keep snow from blocking air intakes and access doors, and the potential for freezing of hydronic heating or steam humidification components must be considered.
- Casing corrosion is a potential problem. Many manufacturers prevent rusting with galvanized or vinyl coatings and other protective measures.
- Outdoor installation can reduce equipment life.
- Humidification options are impractical on a unit by unit basis.
- Depending on building construction, sound levels and transmitted vibration may be excessive.
- Architectural considerations may limit allowable locations or require special screening to minimize visual effect.
- Multiple units might be required.

Design Considerations

Design considerations for single-zone VAV are the same as those in the section on Commercial Outdoor Packaged Systems, with the following exceptions:

- Potential for freezing in cold climates need not be addressed
- VAV systems may require separate supply and return duct openings
- The discussion of accessories and custom-designed equipment does not apply to VAV systems

Factory-installed and wired economizer packages are also available as well as microprocessor-based controls with various control options, including BACnet™ integration.

Refrigeration Equipment. Chapter 38 has information about compressors and Chapters 43 and 48 discuss refrigeration equipment, including the general size ranges of available equipment. Air-cooled condensers are built integral to the equipment.

Air-cooled condensers pass outdoor air over a dry coil to condense the refrigerant. This results in a higher condensing temperature and, thus, a larger power input at peak conditions. However, this peak time may be relatively short over 24 h. The air-cooled condenser is popular in small reciprocating systems because of its low maintenance requirements.

Heating Equipment. Natural-gas, propane, electricity, and sometimes hot-water, steam, and refrigerant gas heating options are available. These are normally incorporated directly into the air-handling sections.

Controls. Zoning for temperature control determines the number of units; each zone has a unit. Zones are determined by the cooling and heating loads for the space served, occupancy, allowable roof loads, flexibility requirements, appearance, duct size limitations, and equipment size availability.

Most operating and safety controls are provided by the equipment manufacturer. Although remote monitoring panels are optional, they are recommended to allow operating personnel to monitor performance.

Acoustics and Vibration. Most unitary equipment is available with limited separate vibration isolation of rotating equipment. Isolation of the entire unit casing is rarely required; however, use care when mounting on light structures. If external isolation is required, it should be coordinated with the unit manufacturer to ensure proper separation of internal versus external isolation deflection.

Outdoor noise from unitary equipment should be reduced to a minimum. Evaluate sound power levels at all property lines. Indoor-radiated noise from the unit's fans, compressors, and condensers travels directly through the roof into occupied space below. Mitigation usually involves adding mass, such as two layers of gypsum board, inside the roof curb beneath the unit. Airborne duct discharge noise, primarily from the fans themselves, can be attenuated by silencers in the supply and return air ducts or by acoustically lined ductwork.

10. AUTOMATIC CONTROLS AND BUILDING MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS

A building management system can be an important tool in achieving sustainable facility energy management. Basic HVAC system controls are electric or electronic, and usually are prepackaged and prewired with equipment at the factory. Controls may also be accessible by the building manager using a remote off-site computer. The next level of HVAC system management is to integrate the manufacturer's control package with the building management system. If the project is an addition or major renovation, prepackaged controls and their capabilities need to be compatible with existing automated controls. Chapter 41 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* discusses computer applications, and ANSI/ASHRAE *Standard* 135 discusses interfacing building automation systems.

11. MAINTENANCE MANAGEMENT

Because they are simpler and more standardized than centralized systems, decentralized systems can often be maintained by less technically trained personnel. Maintenance management for many packaged equipment systems can be specified with a service contract from a local service contracting firm. Frequently, small to mid-level construction projects do not have qualified maintenance technicians on site once the job is turned over to a building owner, and service contracts can be a viable option. These simpler decentralized systems allow competitive solicitation of bids for annual maintenance to local companies.

12. BUILDING SYSTEM COMMISSIONING

Commissioning a building system that has an independent control system to be integrated with individual packaged control systems requires that both control contractors participate in the process. Before the commissioning functional performance demonstrations to the client, it is important to obtain the control contractors' individual point checkout sheets, program logic, and list of points that require confirmation with another trade (e.g., fire alarm system installer).

Frequently, decentralized systems are installed in phases, requiring multiple commissioning efforts based on the construction schedule and owner occupancy. This applies to new construction and expansion of existing installations. During the warranty phase, decentralized system performance should be measured, benchmarked, and course-corrected to ensure the design intent can be achieved. If an energy analysis study is performed as part of the comparison between decentralized and centralized concepts, or life-cycle comparison of the study is part of a Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design (LEED®) project, the resulting month-to-month energy data should be a good electronic benchmark for actual energy consumption using the measurement and verification plan implementation.

Ongoing commissioning or periodic recommissioning further ensures that design intent is met, and that cooling and heating are reliably delivered. Retro- or recommissioning should be considered whenever the facility is expanded or an additional connection made to the existing systems, to ensure the original design intent is met.

The initial testing, adjusting, and balancing (TAB) also contributes to sustainable operation and maintenance. The TAB process should be repeated periodically to ensure levels are maintained.

When completing TAB and commissioning, consider posting laminated system flow diagrams at or adjacent to cooling and heating equipment indicating operating instructions, TAB performance, commissioning functional performance tests, and emergency shut-off procedures. These documents also should be filed electronically in the building manager's computer server for quick reference.

Original basis of design and design criteria should be posted as a constant reminder of design intent, and to be readily available in case troubleshooting, expansion, or modernization is needed.

As with all HVAC applications, to be a sustainable design success, building commissioning should include the system training requirements necessary for building management staff to efficiently take ownership and operate and maintain the HVAC systems over the useful service life of the installation.

Commissioning should continue up through the final commissioning report, approximately one year after the construction phase has been completed and the warranty phase comes to an end. For further details on commissioning, see Chapter 44 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

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CHAPTER 3

CENTRAL COOLING AND HEATING PLANTS

System Characteristics 3.1
Design Considerations 3.2
Equipment 3.5
Distribution Systems 3.7
Sound, Vibration, Seismic, and Wind Considerations 3.8
Space Considerations 3.8
Automatic Controls and Building Management Systems 3.9
Maintenance Management Systems 3.10
Building System Commissioning 3.11
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CENTRAL cooling and/or heating plants generate cooling and/or heating in one location for distribution to multiple locations in one building or an entire campus. Central cooling and heating systems are used in almost all types of buildings, but most commonly in very large buildings and complexes where there is a high density of energy use. This chapter covers plants with cooling and/or heating (referred to as **central plants**). They are especially suited to applications where maximizing equipment service life and using energy and operational workforce efficiently are important.

Good candidates for a central plant have significant loads and a designated mechanical space. Appendix G of ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 shows that central plants are typical in buildings more than five floors high or greater than 14 000 m^2. Smaller buildings may use them for efficiency and control reasons, but the cost per square foot increases as compared to more typical systems. Building or facility types that commonly use central plants include

- Campus environments with distribution to several buildings (described further in Chapter 12).
- High-rise facilities
- Large office buildings (typically over 14 000 m^2)
- Large public assembly facilities, entertainment complexes, stadiums, arenas, and convention and exhibition centers
- Urban centers (e.g., city centers/districts)
- Shopping malls
- Large condominiums, hotels, and apartment complexes
- Educational facilities
- Hospitals and other health care facilities
- Industrial facilities (e.g., pharmaceutical, manufacturing)
- Large museums and similar institutions
- Locations where waste heat is readily available (result of power generation or industrial processes)
- Larger systems where higher efficiency offsets the potentially higher first cost of a chilled-water system

This chapter addresses design alternatives that should be considered for central cooling and heating plants. Distribution system options and equipment are discussed when they relate to the central equipment, but more information on distribution systems can be found in Chapters 11 to 15.

1. SYSTEM CHARACTERISTICS

Central systems are characterized by large chilling and heating equipment located in one facility or multiple installations interconnected to operate as one. Equipment configuration and ancillary equipment vary significantly, depending on the facility's use. Typically, central plants include water-chilling equipment, pumps, and water system specialty items. Boilers are often in a separate mechanical room to provide proper separation from the refrigeration equipment, as required by ASHRAE *Standard* 15. The central plant also typically includes cooling towers and pumps, if it is a water-cooled plant. See Chapter 1 for information on selecting a central cooling or heating plant.

The plant and equipment can be located as part of the facility, or in remote stand-alone plants. Also, different combinations of centralized and decentralized systems (e.g., a central cooling plant and decentralized heating and ventilating systems) can be used.

Chillers and boilers are available in different sizes, capacities, and configurations to serve a variety of building applications. Operating a few pieces of primary equipment (often with back-up equipment) gives central plants different benefits from decentralized systems (see Chapter 2).

Multiple types of equipment and fuel sources can be combined in one plant, but typically only in large plants. The heating and cooling energy may be a combination of electricity, natural gas, oil, coal, solar, geothermal, waste heat, etc. This energy is converted into chilled water, hot water, or steam that is distributed through the facility for air conditioning, heating, and processes. The operating, maintenance, and first costs of all these options should be discussed with the owner before final selection. When combining heating generation systems, it is important to note the presence of direct-firing combustion systems and chilled-water production systems using refrigerants, because ASHRAE *Standard* 15 requires most refrigerants to be isolated from combustion equipment for safety.

A central plant can be customized without sacrificing the standardization, flexibility, and performance required to support the primary cooling and heating equipment by carefully selecting ancillary equipment, automatic control, and facility management. Plant design can vary widely based on building use, life-cycle costs, operating economies, and the need to maintain reliable building HVAC, process, and electrical systems. These systems can require more extensive engineering, equipment, and financial analysis than do decentralized systems.

In large buildings with interior areas that require cooling at the same time perimeter areas require heating, one of several types of centralized heat reclaim units can meet both these requirements efficiently. Chapter 9 describes these combinations, and Chapters 11 to 15 provide design details for central plant systems. Using recovered energy for reheat at the zone level is a common use for lower-grade heat. It can significantly reduce the total energy use of buildings that commonly have simultaneous heating and cooling loads (e.g., hospitals, large hotels). Using recovered energy for reheat is one of the allowed exceptions in ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 for simultaneous heating and cooling.

Central plants can be designed to accommodate both occupied/unoccupied and constant, year-round operation. Maintenance can be performed with traditional one-shift operating crews, but may require 24 h coverage. Higher-pressure steam boiler plants (usually greater than100 kPa [gage]) or combined cogeneration and steam heating plants require multiple-operator, 24 h shift coverage.The need for full-time operating personnel or certified operating engineers is typically defined by the authorities having jurisdiction (AHJs).

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 9.1, Large Building Air-Conditioning Systems.

Advantages

- Simultaneous primary cooling and heating can be provided at all times, independent of the operation mode of equipment and systems beyond the central plant.
- Using larger but fewer pieces of equipment generally reduces the facility's overall operation and maintenance costs. It also allows wider operating ranges and more flexible operating sequences.
- A centralized location minimizes restrictions on servicing accessibility.
- Energy-efficient design strategies, energy recovery, thermal storage, and energy management can be simpler and more cost effective to implement.
- Multiple energy sources can be used in central plants, providing flexibility and leverage when purchasing fuel and in the event of shortages of one or more fuel sources.
- Standardizing equipment can be beneficial for redundancy and stocking replacement parts. However, strategically selecting different-sized equipment for a central plant can provide better part-load capability and efficiency.
- Standby capabilities (capacity/redundancy) and back-up fuel sources can be more easily added to equipment and plant when planned in advance.
- Equipment operation can be staged to match load profile and can allow select pieces of equipment to be taken offline for maintenance.
- A central plant and its distribution can be economically expanded to accommodate future growth (e.g., adding new equipment to the plant or new buildings to the service group).
- Load diversity can substantially reduce the total installed equipment capacity requirement.
- Submetering secondary distribution can allow individual billing of cooling and heating uses outside the central plant.
- Major vibration and sound-producing equipment can be grouped away from occupied spaces, making acoustic and vibration controls simpler. Acoustical treatment can be applied in a single location instead of many separate locations.
- Issues such as cooling tower plume and plant emissions are centralized, allowing a more economic and aesthetically acceptable solution.

Disadvantages

- New or replacement equipment of the required capacity may not be readily available, resulting in long lead time for production and delivery.
- Equipment may be more complicated than decentralized equipment, and thus require more knowledgeable equipment operators.
- A central location within or adjacent to the building(s) served is needed.
- Additional equipment room height may be needed for the larger central plant equipment.
- Depending on the fuel source, large underground or surface storage tanks may be required on site. If coal is used, space for storage bunker(s) will be needed.
- Access may be needed for large deliveries of fuel (oil, propane, wood/biomass, or coal).
- Fossil-fuel-fired heating plants require a chimney or flue and possibly special emission treatment, permits, and/or monitoring.
- Multiple equipment manufacturers are required when combining primary and ancillary equipment in a common facility.
- System control logic may be complex.
- First costs can be higher compared to alternatives with rooftop units (RTUs), water-source heat pumps (WSHPs), self-contained equipment, and other systems.
- Special permitting may be required.
- Safety requirements are increased.
- A large pipe distribution system may be necessary (which may actually be an advantage for some applications).

2. DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

Cooling and Heating Loads

Design cooling and heating loads are determined by considering individual and simultaneous loads. That is, the simultaneous peaks or instantaneous load for all areas served or a block of buildings served by the HVAC and/or process load is less than the sum of the individual peak cooling and heating loads (e.g., buildings do not receive peak solar load on the east and west exposures at the same time). The difference between the sum of the space design loads and system peak load, called the **diversity factor**, can be as little as 5% less than the sum of individual loads (e.g., 95% diversity factor) or can represent a more significant reduction of the plant load (e.g., 45% diversity factor), as is possible in multiple-building applications. Computerized load calculation programs can be used to model different schedules (occupancy, lighting, etc.) with peak thermal loads, to determine appropriate diversity factors. The peak central plant load is typically based on a diversity factor, reducing the total installed equipment capacity serving larger building cooling and heating loads. The design engineer should evaluate the full point-of-use load requirements of each facility served by the central system. It is important to review applicable codes and requirements of the local authority having jurisdiction (AHJ), which may limit the use of diversity factors.

Opportunities for improving energy efficiency include

- Using multiple chillers or boilers can provide better part-load operation, with a wider range of operation without cycling off and on. Using correctly sized equipment is imperative to accurately provide the most flexible and economical sequencing of equipment. Modeling programs or spreadsheets are an excellent way to compare different staging sequences. Controls can handle a greater number of sequences, but controls for special staging will have a higher first cost. Installing more units to deliver the same capacity that can be delivered by a single piece of equipment typically increases the cost and space required. This needs to be checked against the staging and redundancy requirements that multiple units can provide. If multiple units are to be used, the designer must verify that the expected load profiles fit the full load capabilities of one, two, or more of the units installed.
- Rightsizing equipment allows it to operate closer to peak efficiency, as opposed to incorrectly sized units that are forced to operate at low loads for extended periods of time. It also saves on the cost of installing extra capacity.
- For central chiller plants, consider using **variable-frequency drives (VFDs)** on chillers. Multiple VFD installations on chillers allow more flexibility in control and energy efficiency of chiller plant operation. Remember that part-load efficiency increases when the required lift decreases. This occurs when the condensing temperature is lowered (cooler condensing fluid) or the discharge chilled-water temperature is raised.
- Staging cooling towers with the chillers can increase efficiency and reliability by using as much cooling tower surface and fans as possible. Coordinating equipment flow (maximum and minimum at various stages) characteristics is now required by ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 (as of 2013).
- Using exchangers to transfer free or waste energy from one source to another can provide significant savings. This can also allow mechanical equipment to unload or turn off completely on nonpeak days. Examples include recovering condenser water for reheat, recovering energy from a process load to provide free heat, or preheating domestic or laundry water.

Discrete loads (e.g., server rooms) may be best served by an independent system, depending on the load profile of the central plant; a small, independent system, designed for the discrete load, can be the most cost-effective approach to handle the 24/7 server room load while allowing the primary HVAC system to shut off for a significant number of unoccupied hours. Central plants may not be able to reliably serve a small, discrete load. For example, an 8 MW chiller plant serving a large office facility could be selected with two 4 MW chillers. An independent computer room server has a year-round 80 kW load. Operating one 4 MW chiller, plus towers and pumps, at less than 500 kW reliably would be extremely inefficient and possibly detrimental. Serving the discrete load independently allows the designer flexibility to evaluate the chiller plant independent of individual subsystems that may have very different schedules from the main plant.

Peak cooling load time is affected by outdoor ventilation, outdoor dry- and wet-bulb temperatures, hours of occupancy, interior equipment heat gain, and relative amounts of north, east, south, and west exposures. For typical office or classroom buildings with a balanced distribution of solar exposures, the peak usually occurs on a midsummer afternoon when the west solar load and outdoor dry-bulb temperature are at or near concurrent maximums. The peak cooling period can shift if ventilation rates and internal load profiles change significantly, as in a restaurant or high-rise residential building.

Building occupancy diversity can significantly affect the overall diversity factor. For example, in a system serving a high school, the peak cooling period for a classroom is different from that for the administration offices. Planning load profiles at academic facilities requires special consideration. Unlike office and residential applications, educational facilities typically have peak cooling loads during late summer and early fall.

Peak heating load has less opportunity to accommodate a diversity factor, because equipment is most likely to be selected based on the sum of individual heating loads when the spaces are not being used. This load may often occur when the building must be warmed after an unoccupied weekend setback period. Peak demand might occur during unoccupied periods when outdoor temperatures are coldest and there is little internal heat gain, or during occupied times if a significant amount of outdoor air must be preconditioned. To accommodate part-load conditions and energy efficiency, variable flow may be the best economical choice. It is important for the designer to evaluate plant operation and system use. Boiler heating loads can typically be handled with variable flow by using primary/secondary pumping. Some boilers (e.g., condensing) can also be used in variable primary pumping arrangements. Chapter 32 discusses this in greater detail.

Security

The designer needs to evaluate the security requirements as part of the design, commissioning, and maintenance plans for the building. The team should evaluate the building for security risks in terms of intentional (terrorist) acts, accidental events, and natural disasters. Central plants can make it easier to isolate parts of the HVAC system, but components outside the mechanical room or outside the building (e.g., air intakes, power and controls connections) may be of concern.

Special sequences of operation can provide ventilation and isolation during a security event. HVAC and power redundancy, increased filtration, and sensors are typically included in the security plan. Chapter 61 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—Applications* has more detail on developing design, plans, and planned responses to these types of events. Depending on the building function, location, and occupants, the security plan may change. It is very important to remember that early planning and the use of commissioning can reduce the risk of harm to occupants.

System Flow Design

The flow configuration of a central system is based on use and application. **Primary variable flow** uses variable flow through the primary equipment (chiller or heating device) and directly pumps the water to the loads. Variable primary flow typically uses two-way automatic control valves at terminal equipment and variable-frequency drive (VFD) pumping (Figure 1). An older version of variable flow uses distribution pressure control with a bypass valve (Figure 2). This option keeps full flow in the chiller or boiler, but sacrifices the savings of the VFD on the pumps. Both methods control system pressure, usually at the hydraulically most remote point (last control valve and terminal unit) in the water system.

The design engineer should work with the equipment manufacturer to ensure minimum equipment flow rates are maintained throughout the building load profile, and to determine whether any additional components or ancillary equipment is required. Chillers are typically selected with higher water velocities (0.03 to 0.04 m/s) and water pressure drops at full load in the evaporator to provide improved turndown on the water flow while maintaining the required minimum equipment flow. The chilled-water pumps are not dedicated to specific chillers/boilers, but run off of a common header to allow the chillers to operate over a wide range of flows (Figure 1). The valve in the bypass line is closed until system flow drops to the minimum flow of the operating chiller/boiler(s). Flow transitions when staging a chiller off and on are the most critical. Check each chiller's minimum and maximum flow to ensure that the pumps can maintain the required flow rate range from minimum to 100% load. Multiple chillers or those with higher turndown ratios make this easier. Avoid variable primary systems where there are poor controls or limited operator training.

Constant primary/variable secondary flow hydraulically decouples the primary production system (chilled- or heating-water), which is commonly constant flow, from the secondary dis-

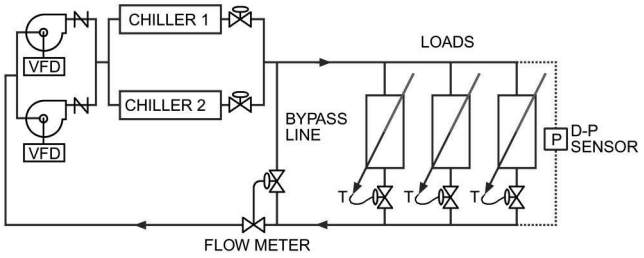

Fig. 1 Primary Variable-Flow System

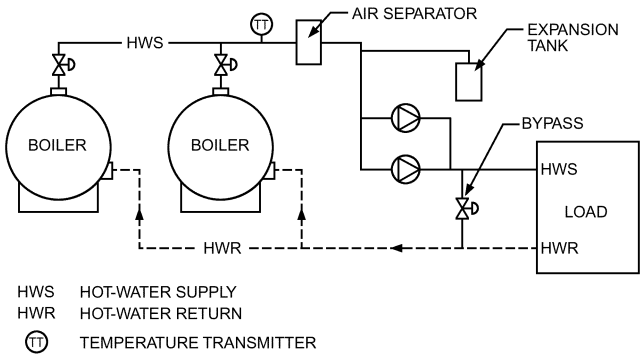

Fig. 2 Primary (Limited) Variable-Flow System Using Distribution Pressure Control

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

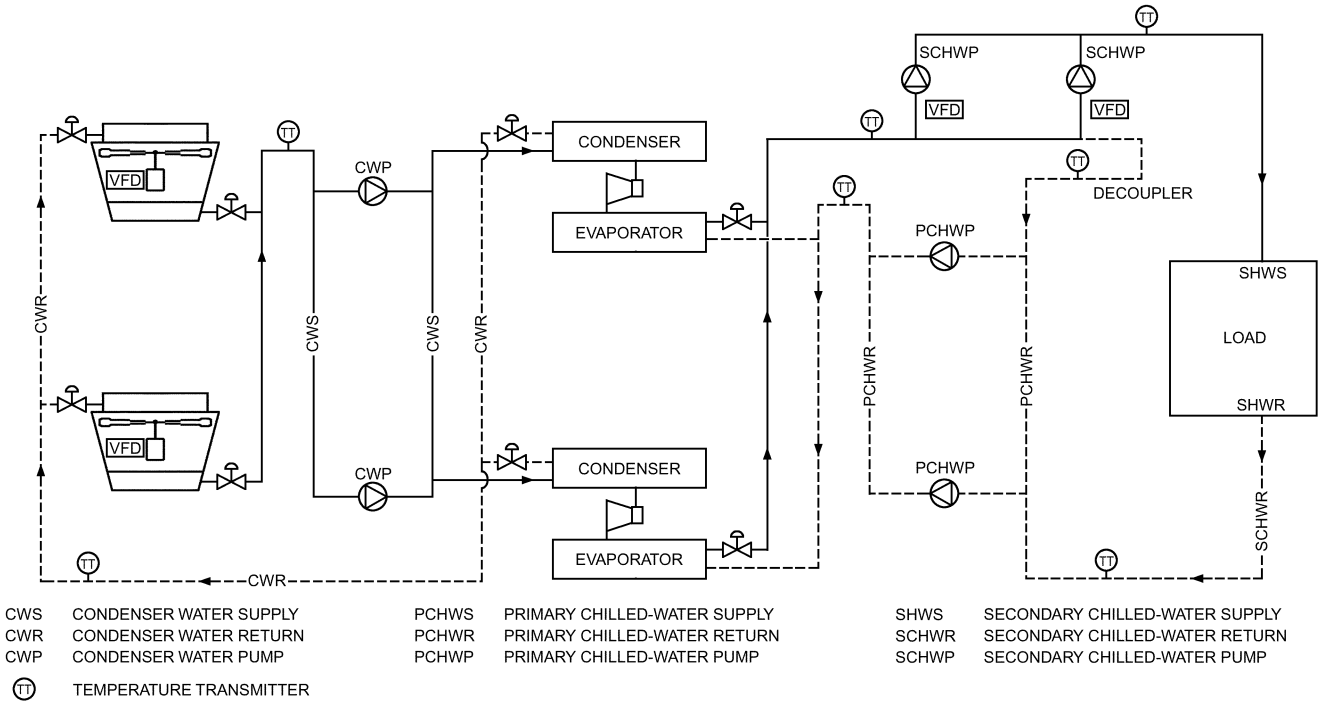

Fig. 3 Primary/Secondary Pumping Chilled-Water System

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

tribution. A variable-flow secondary piping system distributes the chilled or heating medium to the point of use (Figures 3 and 4). This is probably the most common pumping flow arrangement in use, and allows for easy redundancy with all primary components and easy isolation of units as they cycle off or need to be serviced.

Primary/secondary pumping maintains constant design flow in each chiller (or boiler) during operation. The secondary (load) pumps vary their flow rates to match system demand by maintaining a set pressure in the loop. A decoupler line between the primary and secondary loops allows the two sets of pumps to operate at different flow rates. The constant-flow primary helps because many chillers and boilers require full flow or are limited in the amount of flow reduction they can handle.

The primary pumps are sized for the chiller flows and pressure drops associated with the central plant. The secondary pumps are selected for the building flows and their pressure drops, plus the secondary distribution system, which typically exceeds that of the primary loop. This allows for saving on the largest part of the pumping energy by varying the flows on the building loads.

Improved chiller controls and lower VFD costs have made VFDs on primary pumps a flexible and economical way to tune chiller flow without trimming pump impellers or using a throttling valve. Condenser pumps generally need less head capability than the secondary pumps because the towers are typically close. VFDs can be used on these pumps, but they are typically smaller pumps. The designer should be careful when reducing flow on the towers, which can increase the return tower water temperature and chiller energy use. Also, varying flow across the cooling tower can greatly affect tower performance.

In Figure 3, multiple tower cells have been selected to match the number of chillers. Note that running 50% of the water through both cells with each fan at 50% speed uses less energy than one tower at 100% flow and fan speed. The designer should confirm that the towers can handle reduced flow (fairly common with newer towers).

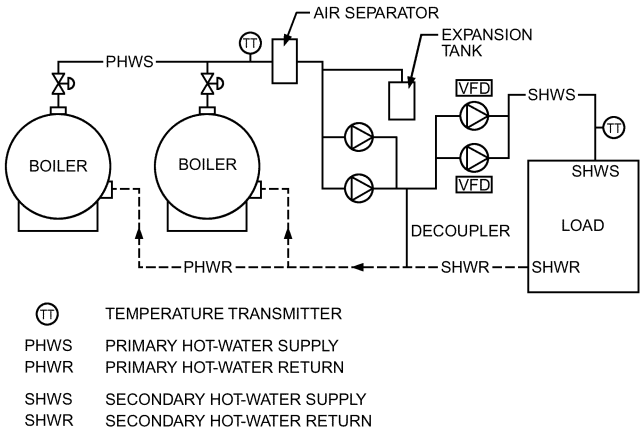

Fig. 4 Primary/Secondary Pumping Hot-Water System

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

When using either primary/secondary or primary variable-flow designs, the engineer should understand the design differences between the use of two- and three-way modulating valves (see Chapter 46).

Variable-flow designs modulate chilled- or heating-water flow through the distribution loop. As terminal units satisfy demand, a two-way valve modulates toward closed, causing the system pressure to increase above the design point. To compensate, a VFD reduces pump speed, thereby reducing flow and pressure to the control point. Pump speed is usually controlled by a differential pressure sensor. Other recent technologies sense valve positions throughout the system and optimize flow accordingly. As the pressure differential increases (the result of valves closing), the VFD reduces speed to maintain the pressure set point. As system demand

requires increased flow, the control valves modulate open, reducing system differential pressure. The reduction in differential pressure causes the VFD to increase pump speed to maintain the pressure set point and meet system flow demand.

Care should be taken during design to ensure minimum flow is achieved in the secondary loop under part-load operation throughout the system. When selecting the distribution system pump, ensure distribution flow does not exceed production flow, which could cause a temperature drop in the secondary loop if flow exceeds demand, leading to **low ΔT syndrome** (see, e.g., Taylor [2002]). The engineer should evaluate operational conditions at part load to minimize the potential for this to occur

With primary variable-flow, a single set of pumps modulates the primary chilled- or heating-water flow, using a VFD to control pump speed. Primary variable-flow systems use modulating two-way control valves across each heat transfer device (as in the primary/secondary system). Chillers and boilers have minimum water flow rates that must be maintained to ensure proper operation. A bypass or other method to maintain minimum flows must be installed if the minimum system loads can be less than the minimum equipment limits.

An older design, which has been used for many years, is a straight **constant-volume primary** system. Hydronic pumps distribute water through the energy equipment and to the point of use. Both pumping energy and distribution flow are constant. This design is best suited to stable process loads, or may be seen in older systems that were installed before VFDs were common. Constant flow generally requires three-way valves to maintain the minimum required flow rate through generating equipment and not over pump the coils and loads. These systems are usually much more expensive to operate and, therefore, less attractive in central HVAC systems. Take care with this type of design, because many current energy codes (including ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1) do not allow using pump motors without variable-frequency drives.

Energy Recovery and Thermal Storage

Energy recovery and thermal storage strategies can be applied to a central cooling and heating plant. See ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 for systems and conditions requiring energy recovery. Water-to-water energy recovery systems are common and readily available. Thermal storage using water or ice storage can be adapted to central plants. See Chapter 26 in this volume and Chapters 35 to 37 and 42 in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information on energy-related opportunities. Thermal energy storage (TES) systems may offer strategies for both part-load and peak-load energy reduction. Base-loading plant operation for a more flat-line energy consumption profile of a large plant, for example, may help reduce energy costs. Thermal energy storage of chilled water, ice, or heating water offers a medium for capacity redundancy, with potential reductions in both heating and cooling infrastructure equipment sizing.

3. EQUIPMENT

Primary Refrigeration Equipment

Chillers are the major cooling equipment in central plants. They chill water or other low-temperature fluid, which is then pumped throughout the buildings served. Chillers vary in type and application, and fall into two major categories: (1) vapor-compression refrigeration (compressorized) chillers, and (2) absorption-cycle chillers. The chiller plant may have either, or a combination of, these machine types. Cooling towers, air-cooled condensers, evaporative condensers, or some combination are also needed to reject heat from this equipment. Energy for the prime driver of cooling equipment may also come from waste heat from a combined heat and power (CHP) system or other energy-using system that would normally reject heat to the atmosphere. Chapters 38 and 43 discuss refrigeration equipment, including the size range of available equipment.

Compressorized chillers feature scroll, helical rotary (screw), and centrifugal compressors, which may be driven by electric motors; natural gas-, diesel-, or oil-fired internal combustion engines; combustion turbines; or steam turbines. Compressor selection typically depends on capacity, first-cost budget limitations, and life-cycle cost.

Compressors are a part of the chiller that also includes the evaporator, condenser, safety and operating controls, and possibly a VFD to control the compressor driver. Reciprocating and helical rotary compressor units can be field assembled and include air- or water-cooled (evaporative) condensers designed for remote installation. Centrifugal compressors are usually included in larger packaged chillers, though they can be field erected on very-large-capacity chiller systems. Chillers require heat rejection equipment that can be unit mounted or remote, as well as air or water cooled. Chapter 38 has more detailed information about compressors.

Absorption chillers may be single or double effect. These terms refer to the number of times the solution is distilled, with double effect typically being higher capacity and more efficient, but using more energy than single effect. Like centrifugal chillers, absorption chillers require cooling towers to reject heat. Absorption chillers use a lithium bromide/water cycle in which the lithium bromide/water solution is the refrigerant. They are generally available in the following configurations: (1) natural gas direct fired, (2) indirect generated by low pressure steam or hot water, (3) indirect generated by high-pressure steam or high-temperature hot water, and (4) indirect generated by hot exhaust gas. Chapter 18 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* discusses absorption air-conditioning and refrigeration equipment in more detail.

Ancillary Refrigeration Equipment

Ancillary equipment for central cooling plants consists primarily of heat-rejection equipment (air-cooled condensers, evaporative condensers, and cooling towers), pumps (primary, secondary, and tertiary), and heat exchangers (water-to-water). For more detailed information, see Chapters 26, 39, 40, and 42 to 47.

As part of a packaged air-cooled chiller, **air-cooled condensers** pass outdoor air over a dry coil to condense the refrigerant. This can result in a higher condensing temperature than a water-cooled condenser would provide, and thus a higher power input at peak condition (though peak time may be relatively short over a 24 h period). Newer designs for air-cooled chillers can offer larger condenser surfaces to provide efficiencies closer to those of water-cooled units without the requirement for a cooling tower. Air-cooled condensers are popular with scroll and screw compressors, which can handle a wide range of ambient air temperatures. They generally have lower maintenance requirements, but incur a penalty for using the dry-bulb temperature as opposed to the wet-bulb temperature used by water-cooled equipment. Air-cooled equipment may be appropriate in high-wet-bulb environments, because cooling tower supply water temperature is a function of the wet-bulb temperature. They are also more common in smaller systems and in cooler climates that require more freeze protection and have lower peak temperatures.

Evaporative condensers pass outdoor air over coils sprayed with water, thus taking advantage of the heat that is absorbed in the evaporation process to lower the condensing temperature. Freeze prevention and close control of water treatment are required for successful operation. The lower power consumption of the refrigeration system and much smaller footprint of the evaporative condenser are gained at the expense of the cost of water and water treatment used and increased maintenance cost.

Cooling towers provide heat rejection by passing outdoor air through an open condenser return water spray to achieve adiabatic

cooling performance. Either natural or mechanical-draft cooling towers or spray ponds can be used; the mechanical-draft tower (forced draft, induced draft, or ejector) can be designed for most conditions because it does not depend on wind. Cooling tower types and sizes range from packaged units to field-erected towers with multiple cells in unlimited sizes. Location of cooling towers should consider issues such as reingestion or short-circuiting of discharge heat rejection air, tower plume, proximity to outdoor air intakes, and the effect of drift on adjacent roadways, buildings, and parking lots. As with evaporative condensers, freeze protection may be required. Water treatment is necessary for successful operation to prevent scaling, biological growth (e.g., *Legionella*), and to prevent corrosion. More detail on cooling towers can be found in Chapter 14.

Makeup water subtraction meters should be evaluated for both evaporative condensers and cooling towers by the design engineer or owner. In many areas, sewage costs are part of the overall water bill, and most domestic water supplied to a typical facility goes into the sewage system. However, evaporated condenser water is not drained to sewer, and if a utility-grade meter is used to measure the difference between makeup and blowdown water quantity, potential savings can be available to the owner for water not discharged into the sewer. Metering should be evaluated with chilled-water plants, especially those in operation year-round. Consult with the water supplier to identify compliance requirements. Consider piping cooling tower water blowdown and drainage (e.g., to remove dissolved solids or allow maintenance when installing subtraction meters) to the storm drainage system, but note that environmental effects of the water chemistry must be evaluated before taking this step. Where chemical treatment conditions do not meet environmental outfall requirements, drainage to the sanitary system may still be required unless prefiltration can be incorporated.

Water pumps move both chilled and condenser water to and from the refrigeration equipment and associated ancillary equipment. Different pumping arrangements can provide operational savings associated with variable speed pumps, but ways to address application issues such as equipment staging or low ΔT syndrome should be considered. See Chapter 44 for additional information on centrifugal pumps, and Chapters 12 to 14 for system design.

Pumps should be headered to allow them to operate with any (as shown in Figures 1 to 3). Dedicating pumps to a chiller boiler or tower cell reduces redundancy and limits flow options to equipment.

Heat exchangers provide both operational and energy recovery cost-saving opportunities for central cooling plants. Operational opportunities often involve heat transfer between building systems that must be kept separated because of different pressures, media, cleanliness, etc. For example, heat exchangers can thermally link a low-pressure, low-rise building system with a high-pressure, high-rise building system. Heat exchangers can also transfer heat between chemically treated or open, contaminated water systems and closed, clean water systems (e.g., between a central cooling plant chilled-water system and a highly purified, process cooling water system, or potentially dirty pond water and a closed-loop condenser water system).

To conserve energy, water-to-water heat exchangers can provide water-side economizer opportunities. When outdoor conditions allow, condenser water can cool chilled water through a heat exchanger, using the cooling tower and pumps rather than a compressor. This approach should be considered when year-round chilled water is needed to satisfy a process load, or when an air-side economizer is not possible because of design requirements or limitations (e.g., space humidity requirements, lack of space for the required ductwork).Water-side economizers can also save on humidification costs in cold, dry climates by reducing the percentage of cold, dry outdoor air delivery to the building from air-side economizers.

Plant Controls. Direct digital control (DDC) systems should be considered for control accuracy and reliability. Temperature, flow, and energy use are best measured and controlled with modern DDC technology. Electric actuation is most common. Pneumatic actuation might be considered where torque or rapid response of powered actuation is required; medium-pressure air supply (typically 200 to 400 kPa [gage]) is best. Consider using programmable logic controllers (PLCs) for plants where future expansion/growth is a possibility and changes to DDC controls would be cost prohibitive. Smaller plants can use the onboard chiller control panel, providing a simplified control system at a lower installed cost.

Codes and Standards. Specific code requirements and standards apply when designing central cooling plants. For cooling equipment, refer to ASHRAE *Standard* 15; Chapter 51 of this volume provides a comprehensive list of codes and standards associated with cooling plant design, installation, and operation. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1, the *International Energy Conservation Code*® (IECC®; ICC [2018]), or local energy standards typically govern minimum equipment efficiencies, acceptable control sequences, economizer use, and other details. Follow manufacturers' recommendations and federal, state, and local codes and standards.

Primary Heating Equipment

Boilers are the major heating equipment used in central heating plants. They vary in type and application, and include combined heat and power (CHP) equipment and waste heat boilers. Chapter 32 discusses boilers in detail, including the size ranges of typical equipment.

A boiler adds heat to the working medium, which is then distributed throughout the building(s) and/or campus. The working medium may be either water or steam, which can further be classified by temperature and pressure range. Steam, often used to transport energy over long distances, is converted to low-temperature hot water in a heat exchanger near the point of use. Although steam is an acceptable medium for heat transfer, low-temperature hot water is the most common and a more uniform and more easily controlled medium for providing heating and process heat (e.g., heating water to 93°C for heating and up to 60 to 71°C for domestic hot water). Elevated steam pressures and high-temperature hot-water boilers are also used. Both hot-water and steam boilers have the same type of construction criteria, based on operating temperature and pressure.

A boiler may be purchased as a package that includes the burner, fire chamber, heat exchanger section, flue gas passage, fuel train, and necessary safety and operating controls. Cast-iron and water-side boilers can be field-assembled, but fire-tube, scotch marine, and waste-heat boilers are usually packaged units.

Energy Sources. The energy used by a boiler (i.e., its fuel source) may be electricity, natural gas or propane, oil, coal, or combustible waste material, though natural gas and fossil-fuel oil (No. 2, 4, or 6 grade) are most common, either alone or in combination. Selecting a fuel source requires a detailed analysis of energy prices and availability (e.g., natural gas and primary electrical power). The availability of fuel oil or coal delivery is affected by road access and storage for deliveries.

Energy for heating may also come from waste heat from a CHP system. Plant production efficiency is improved when waste heat can be reclaimed and transferred to a heat source. A heat recovery generator can be used to convert the heat byproduct of electric generation to steam or hot water to meet a facility's heating needs when the thermal load meets or exceeds the heat rejection capacity of the electric generation. This can help with cost-effective plant operation.

Additionally, attention to the design of an efficient and maintainable **condensate return** system for a central steam distribution plant is important. A well-designed condensate return system in-

creases overall efficiencies and reduces both chemical and makeup water use.

Codes and Standards. Specific code requirements and standards apply when designing central heating boiler plants. It is important to note that for some applications (e.g., high-pressure boilers) and in some locations, continuous attendance by licensed operators is required for the area of the heating surface. Operating cost considerations should be included in determining such applications. Numerous codes, standards, and manufacturers' recommendations need to be followed. Refer to Chapter 51 for a comprehensive list of codes and standards associated with this equipment, plant design, installation, and operation, and consult local or state fuel gas code requirements.

Ancillary Heating Equipment

Steam Plants. Boiler feed equipment, including the receiver(s) and associated pump(s), serve as a reservoir for condensate and makeup water waiting to be used by the steam boiler. The boiler feed pump provides system condensate and water makeup back to the boiler on an as-needed basis, at the delivery pressure of the steam supply.

Deaerators help eliminate oxygen and carbon dioxide from the feed water or steam to reduce the corrosive and detrimental effects of those contaminants (see Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information).

Chemicals can be fed using several methods or a combination of methods, depending on the chemical(s) used (e.g., chelants, amines, oxygen scavengers).

Surge tanks are also applicable to steam boiler plants to accommodate large quantities of condensate water return and are primarily used where there is a rapid demand for steam (e.g., morning start-up of a central heating plant).

See Chapter 11 for more information on steam systems.

Hot-Water Plants. Ancillary equipment associated with central hot-water heating plants consists primarily of pumps and possibly heat exchanger(s). Water pumps move hot-water supply and return to and from the boiler equipment and associated ancillary equipment. See Chapter 44 for additional information on centrifugal pumps, as well as Chapters 11 to 13 and Chapter 15 for system design.

Heat Exchangers. Heat exchangers offer operational and energy recovery opportunities for central heating plants. Operational opportunities for heat exchangers involve combining steam system heating delivery capabilities with hot-water heating system supply and control capabilities.

Air-to-water and water-to-water heat exchangers provide opportunities for economizing and heat recovery in a central heating plant (e.g., flue gas exhaust heat recovery and boiler blowdown heat recovery).

For more detailed information on ancillary equipment, see Chapters 31 to 33 and Chapter 35.

4. DISTRIBUTION SYSTEMS

The major piping in a central cooling plant can include, but is not limited to, chilled-water, condenser water, city water, natural gas, fuel oil, refrigerant, vent, and drainage systems. For a central steam heating plant, the major piping includes steam supply, condensate return, pumped condensate, boiler feed, city water (and/or softened or otherwise treated water), natural gas, fuel oil, vent, and drainage systems. For a central hot-water heating plant, it includes hot-water supply and return, city water, natural gas, fuel oil, vent, and drainage systems. In the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, see Chapter 22 for information on sizing pipes, and Chapter 38 for identification, color-coding, abbreviations, and symbols for piping systems.

Design selection of cooling and heating temperature set points (supply and return water) can affect first and operating costs. Water systems with a large temperature difference between supply and return water have lower flow requirements and can allow smaller pipe sizing and smaller valves, fittings, and insulation, which can lower installation cost. However, these savings may be offset by the larger coils and heat exchangers at the point of use needed to accomplish the required heat transfer. A similar design strategy can be achieved by reviewing the steam pressure differential.

Determining the optimum cooling and heating water supply and return temperatures requires design consideration of equipment performance, particularly the energy required to produce the supply water temperature. Although end users set water temperatures, the colder the cooling water, the more energy is needed by the chiller, and conversely, the warmer the return water, the less energy is consumed by the chiller. Similar issues affect hot-water supply temperature and steam operating pressure. Supply water reset may be used when peak capacity is not needed, potentially reducing energy consumption. This reduces chiller power input, but those savings may be offset by increased pump power input due to higher water flows required to achieve the needed capacity. Also, raising chilled-water temperatures diminishes the latent removal capacity of cooling and dehumidification equipment, and may adversely affect control of interior humidity.

Energy implications for the whole system must be considered. The design engineer should consider using higher temperature differences between supply and return to reduce the pump energy required by the distribution system, for both heating and chilled-water systems. Additionally, central plant production systems (e.g., boilers, steam-to-heating-water converters, chillers) operate more efficiently with higher return water temperatures.

During conceptual planning and design, or as early in design as possible, the engineer should evaluate the type(s) of facilities (existing and planned future) to which the central system will deliver service. When using variable-flow distribution with a constant design temperature differential between the supply and return medium, it is critical to avoid low ΔT syndrome (see, e.g., Taylor [2002]). The engineer should attempt to ensure this condition is minimized or avoided, or at minimum, perform due diligence to make the owner aware of the potential shortfalls where this is allowed to occur. With existing constant-flow/variable-temperature systems, take measures to avoid losing the conceptual design strategy of a variable-flow/constant-temperature split. Examples of connection strategies that are less costly than full renovation of a connected facility are (1) return recirculation control, to maintain a design temperature difference across a facility connection, or (2) separation of primary distribution supply from the secondary facility connection by a plate-and-frame heat exchanger with a control valve on the primary return controlled by the secondary supply to the facility. If reduction of temperature differential is allowed, increased flow of the medium through the distribution system will be required to accomplish the same capacity. This increase in flow increases pump power and chiller plant energy, compromising the available capacity and operation of the system.

Consider hydraulically modeling the cooling and heating media (chilled water, heating water, steam, domestic water, natural gas, etc.). With an emphasis on centralizing the source of cooling and heating, a performance template can be created for large plants by computerized profiling of cooling and heating delivery. Hydraulic modeling provides the economic benefits of predesigning the built-out completed system before installing the initial phase of the project. The model also helps troubleshoot existing systems, select pumps, project energy usage, and develop operation strategy.

Energy conservation and management can best be achieved with computerized design and facility management resources to

simulate delivery and then monitor and measure the actual distribution performance.

5. SOUND, VIBRATION, SEISMIC, AND WIND CONSIDERATIONS

Sound and Vibration

Proper space planning is key to sound and vibration control in central plant design. For example, central plants are frequently located at or below grade. This provides a very stable platform for vibration isolation and greatly reduces the likelihood of vibration being transmitted into the occupied structure, where it can be regenerated as sound. Also, locating the central ventilation louvers or other openings away from sound- and vibration-sensitive areas greatly reduces the potential for problems in those areas. As a guide, maintain free area around louvers as specified in ASHRAE *Standard* 15.

Vibration and sound transmitted both into the space served by the plant and to neighboring buildings and areas should be considered in determining how much acoustical treatment is appropriate for the design, especially if the plant is located near sensitive spaces such as conference rooms, sleeping quarters, or residences. See the section on Space Considerations for further discussion of space planning.

Acoustics must also be considered for equipment outside the central plant. For example, roof-mounted cooling tower fans sometimes transmit significant vibration to the building structure and generate ambient sound. Many communities limit machinery sound pressure levels at the property line, which affects the design and placement of equipment. See Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more detailed information on sound and vibration.

Seismic and Wind Issues

Depending on code requirements and the facility's location with respect to seismic fault lines, seismic bracing may be required for the central plant equipment and distribution systems. For instance, a hospital located in a seismically active area must be able to remain open and operational to treat casualties in the aftermath of an earthquake. Additionally, outdoor equipment in some areas needs appropriate bracing for wind loads. This is particularly apparent in critical operations facilities in areas susceptible to hurricanes or tornadoes. Most building codes require that measures such as anchors and bracing be applied to the HVAC system. Refer to the local authority responsible for requirements, and to Chapter 56 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for design guidance.

6. SPACE CONSIDERATIONS

In the very early phases of building design, architects, owners, and space planners often ask the engineer to estimate how much building space will be needed for mechanical equipment. The type of mechanical system selected, building configuration, and other variables govern the space required, and many experienced engineers have developed rules of thumb to estimate the building space needed. Although few buildings are identical in design and concept, some basic criteria apply to most buildings and help approximate final space allocation requirements. These space requirements are often expressed as a percentage of the total building floor area; the combined mechanical and electrical space requirement of most buildings is 6 to 9% of total building area.

Space for chillers, pumps, and towers should not only include installation footprints but should also account for adequate clearance to perform routine and major maintenance. Generally, 1.2 m service clearance (or the equipment manufacturer's minimum required clearance, whichever is greater) around equipment for operator maintenance and service is sufficient. For chillers and boilers, one end or side of the equipment should be provided with free space, to allow for tube pull clearance. In many cases, designers provide service bay roll-up doors or removable ventilation louvers (if winter conditions do not cause freeze damage issues) to allow tube access. Overhead service height is also required, especially where chillers are installed. Provision for 6 m ceilings in a central plant is not uncommon, to accommodate piping, component removal, and service clearance dimensions.

Plant designs incorporating steam supply from a separate central boiler plant may use steam-to-heating-water converters and the heating distribution equipment (e.g., pumps) along with the chilled-water production equipment and distribution infrastructure. Where a boiler installation and associated heating distribution equipment and appurtenances are required, the plant's physical size increases to account for the type of boiler and required exhaust emissions treatment. Generally, for central heating plants, steam or heating water and chilled-water production systems must be separated during design, which may further increase the overall footprint of the plant. (Refer to ASHRAE *Standard* 15 for limitations.)

The arrangement and strategic location of the mechanical spaces during planning affects the percentage of space required. For example, the relationship between outdoor air intakes and loading docks, exhaust, and other contaminating sources should be considered during architectural planning. The final mechanical room size, orientation, and location are established after discussion with the architect and owner. The design engineer should keep the architect, owner, and facility engineer informed, whenever possible, about the HVAC analysis and system selection. Space criteria should satisfy both the architect and the owner or owner's representative, though this often requires some compromise. The design engineer should strive to understand the owner's needs and desires and the architect's vision for the building, while fully explaining the advantages, disadvantages, risks, and rewards of various options for mechanical and electrical room size, orientation, and location. All systems should be coordinated during the space-planning stage to safely and effectively operate and maintain the central cooling and heating plant.

In addition, the mechanical engineer sometimes must represent other engineering disciplines in central plant space planning. If so, it is important for the engineer to understand the basics of electrical and plumbing required for central plant equipment. The main electrical transformer and switchgear rooms should be located as close to the incoming electrical service as practical. The main electric transformers and switchgear for the plant and the mechanical equipment switchgear panels should be in separate rooms that only authorized electricians can enter. If there is an emergency generator, it should be located considering (1) proximity to emergency electrical loads, (2) sources of combustion and cooling air, (3) fuel sources, (4) ease of properly venting exhaust gases outside, and (5) provisions for sound control.

The main plumbing equipment usually contains gas and domestic water meters, the domestic hot-water system, the fire protection system, and elements such as compressed air, special gases, and vacuum, sewage ejector, and sump pumps. Some water and gas utilities require a remote outdoor meter location.

The heating and air-conditioning equipment room houses the (1) boiler, pressure-reducing station, or both; (2) refrigeration machines, including chilled-water and condensing-water pumps; (3) converters for furnishing hot or cold water for heating and/or air conditioning; (4) control air compressors, if any; (5) vacuum and condensate pumps; and (6) miscellaneous equipment. For both chillers and boilers, especially in a centralized application, full access is needed on all sides (including overhead) for extended operation, maintenance, annual inspections of tubes, and tube replacement and repair. Where appropriate, the designer should

include overhead structural elements to allow safe rigging of equipment. Ideally, large central facilities should include overhead cranes or gantries. It is critical to consult local codes and ASHRAE *Standard* 15 for special equipment room requirements. Many jurisdictions require monitoring, alarms, evacuation procedures, separating refrigeration and fuel-fired equipment, and high rates of purge ventilation.

A proper operating environment for equipment and those maintaining it must also be provided. This may involve heating the space for freeze protection and/or cooling the space to prevent overheating motors and controls. HVAC equipment serving the central plant itself may be housed in its own equipment room and serve the chiller, boiler room, and adjacent rooms (e.g., switchgear room, office space, generator room, pump room, machine shop). Where refrigeration equipment is installed, follow design requirements in ASHRAE *Standard* 15.

Location of Central Plant and Equipment

Although large central plants are most often located at or below grade, it is often economical to locate the refrigeration plant at the top of the building, on the roof, or on intermediate floors. In flood-prone areas, an above-grade installation can provide necessary protection against submersion of critical equipment. For central plants, on-grade should be the first choice, followed by below grade. The designer must always ensure access for maintenance and component or total replacement. Locating major equipment in roof penthouses may pose significant access problems for repair and replacement. For single high-rise central plants, intermediate-floor locations that are closer to the load may allow pumping equipment to operate at a lower pressure. A life-cycle cost analysis (LCCA) should include differences in plant location to identify the most attractive plant sustainability options during the planning stage. The LCCA should consider equipment maintenance access, repair, and replacement during the life of the plant, as determined in the owner's criteria. If not identified, an engineer should suggest to the owner or client that maintenance criteria be included as a component in developing the LCCA (see the section on Maintenance Management Systems). Electrical service and structural costs are greater when intermediate-floor instead of ground-level locations are used, but may be offset by reduced energy consumption and condenser and chilled-water piping costs. The boiler plant may also be placed on the roof, eliminating the need for a chimney through the building.

Benefits of locating the air-cooled or evaporative condenser and/or cooling tower on the ground versus the roof should be evaluated. Personnel safety, security, ambient sound, and contamination from hazardous water vapors are some of the considerations that help determine final equipment location. Also, structural requirements (e.g., steel to support roof-mounted equipment, or a concrete pad and structural steel needed to locate equipment at or near grade) require evaluation. When locating a cooling tower at or near grade, the net positive suction head on the pump suction and overflow of condenser water out of the cooling tower sump should be studied if the tower is below, at, or slightly above the level of the condenser water pump or chiller.

Numerous variables should be considered when determining the optimum location of a central cooling or heating plant. When locating the plant, consider the following:

- Operating mass of the equipment and its effect on structural costs
- Vibration from primary and ancillary equipment and its effect on adjacent spaces in any direction
- Sound levels from primary and ancillary equipment and their effect on adjacent spaces in any direction
- Location of electrical utilities for the central plant room, including primary electric service and associated switchgear and motor control center, as well as electrical transformer location and its entrance into the building
- Location of city water and fire pump room (it may be desirable to consolidate these systems near the central plant room)
- Accessibility into the area and clearances around equipment for employee access, equipment and material delivery, and major equipment replacement, repair, scheduled teardown, and rigging
- Location of cooling, refrigerant relief piping, heating, vents, and boiler flue and stack distribution out of the central plant and into the building, along with the flow path of possible vented hazardous chemical, steam, or combustion exhaust products
- Need for shafts to provide vertical distribution of cooling and heating services in the building
- Future expansion plans of the central plant (e.g., oversizing the central plant now for adding more primary equipment later, based on master planning of the facility)
- Architectural effect on the site
- Location of boiler chimney/flue
- Loading dock for materials and supplies
- Roadway and parking considerations
- Storage of fuel
- Electrical transformer location
- Underground and/or overhead utility and central cooling and heating system distribution around the central plant and to the building(s)
- Wind effect on cooling tower plume or other volatile discharges such as boiler emissions.

Central Plant Security

Security around a central plant must be considered in design, and should include standby electrical power generation and production of central cooling and heating for critical applications in times of outages or crisis.

Restricted access and proper location of exposed intakes and vents must be designed into the central plant layout to protect the facility from attack and protect people from injury. Use care in locating exposed equipment, vents, and intakes, especially at ground level. Above ground and at least 3 to 4.5 m from access to intake face is preferred for the location of intakes. When this is not possible, fencing around exposed equipment, such as cooling towers and central plant intakes, should be kept locked at all times to prevent unauthorized access. Ensure that fencing is open to airflow so it does not adversely affect equipment performance. Air intakes should be located above street level if possible, and vents should be directed so they cannot discharge directly on passing pedestrians or into an air intake of the same or an adjacent facility.

7. AUTOMATIC CONTROLS AND BUILDING MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS

One advantage of central cooling and heating plants is easier implementation of building automation because the major and ancillary equipment is consolidated in one location. Computerized automatic controls can significantly affect system performance. A facility management system to monitor system points and overall system performance should be considered for any large, complex air-conditioning system. This allows a single operator to monitor performance at many points in a building and make adjustments to increase occupant comfort and to free maintenance staff for other duties. Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* describes design and application of controls.

Software to consider when designing, managing, and improving central plant performance should include the following:

- Automatic controls that can interface with other control software (e.g., equipment manufacturers' unit-mounted controls)
- Energy management system (EMS) control

- Hydraulic modeling, as well as metering and monitoring of distribution systems
- Using VFDs on equipment (e.g., chillers, pumps, cooling tower fans) to improve system control and to control energy to consume only the energy required to meet the design parameters (e.g., temperature, flow, pressure).
- Computer-aided facility management (CAFM) for integrating other software (e.g., record drawings, operation and maintenance manuals, asset database)
- Computerized maintenance management software (CMMS)
- Automation from other trades (e.g., fire alarm, life safety, medical gases, etc.)
- Regulatory functions (e.g., refrigerant management, federal, state and local agencies, etc.)
- Use of three-dimensional/building information modeling (BIM) in plant design that can be incorporated into the operational and maintenance scheme when the plant is completed and placed in operation

Automatic controls for central cooling and/or heating plants may include standard equipment manufacturer's control logic along with optional, enhanced energy-efficiency control logic. These specialized control systems can be based on different architectures such as distributed controls, programmable logic controllers, or microprocessor-based systems. Beyond standard control technology, the following control points and strategies may be needed for primary equipment, ancillary equipment, and the overall system:

- Discharge temperatures and/or pressures to verify component operation
- Return and supply temperatures to monitor and control ΔT
- Head pressure for refrigerant and/or water to ensure compressors and pumps are operating correctly
- Stack temperature to ensure boilers are operating properly
- Carbon monoxide and/or carbon dioxide levels (can indicate over- or underventilation)
- Differential pressures (indicate whether flow or pressure drops are changing)
- Flow rates of supply and return water and air, ventilation, etc. (all indicate energy use)
- Peak and hourly refrigeration output
- Peak and hourly heat energy output
- Peak and hourly steam output
- Flow rate of fuel(s) and electric demand by type of use
- Temperature and/or pressure set points and status
- Night setback status and set points
- Economizer cycle status and set points
- Variable flow through equipment and/or system control
- Variable-frequency drive speeds, set points, and override status
- Thermal storage control set points, charge mode, and percent capacity
- Heat recovery cycle temperatures and performance
- Occupancy status and override settings
- Local weather conditions, including dry-bulb temperature, dew point, and forecast
- History of these data points and building performance

See Chapter 43 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information on control strategies and optimization.

The **coefficient of performance (COP)** for the entire chilled-water plant can be monitored and allows the plant operator to determine the overall operating efficiency of a plant. Central plant COP can be expressed in the following terms:

- Annual heating or refrigeration per unit of building area (kilowatts per square metre per year)
- Energy used per unit of refrigeration (megajoules per kilowatt)
- Annual power required per unit of refrigeration per unit of building area (kilowatts per kilowatt of refrigeration per square metre per year)

Instrumentation

It is very important to measure and track performance of HVAC equipment to ensure that it is performing as intended and not drifting over time. Making it easier for personnel to review and trend the data is a key step in continuous commissioning. Dashboards and trending graphs can provide immediate visual representations of energy use and efficiency to highlight problems and items that need to be addressed.

Whole-building and occupancy measurements are useful for scheduling and usage issues (some of the most common and wasteful problems). Additional breakdowns of energy use by type and zone (chiller, boiler, fans, lights, etc.) allows better tracking and conservation over time. Some codes require separate power meters and trending by type of use.

All instrument operations where cooling or heating output are measured should have instrumentation calibration that is traceable to the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST).

The importance of local gages and indicating devices, with or without a facility management system, should not be overlooked. All equipment must have adequate pressure gages, thermometers, flow meters, balancing devices, and dampers for effective performance, monitoring, and commissioning (see also ASHRAE *Guideline* 22). In addition, capped thermometer wells, gage cocks, capped duct openings, and volume dampers should be installed at strategic points for system balancing. Chapter 39 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* indicates the locations and types of fittings required. Chapter 37 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* has more information on measurement and instruments.

8. MAINTENANCE MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS

A review with the end user (owner) should be done, to understand the owner's requirements for operation (e.g., if an owner has an in-house staff, more frequent access may be required, which may affect the extent to which a designer incorporates access). Reviewing ASHRAE *Guideline* 4 and *Standard* 15 with the owner can provide insight to the development of a maintenance plan. If maintenance is outsourced, extensive access may not be as high a priority. In some cases, regulatory and code access may be the only determining factors.

Operations and maintenance considerations include the following:

- Accessibility around equipment, as well as above and below when applicable, with at least minimum clearances provided per manufacturers' recommendations and applicable codes (typical space required for regular service is often larger than the minimums, which eases the burden on maintenance staff)
- Clearances for equipment removal
- Minimizing tripping hazards (e.g., drain piping extending along the floor)
- Adequate headroom to avoid injuries
- Trenching in floor, if necessary
- Cable trays, if applicable
- Adequate lighting levels
- Task lighting, when needed
- Eyewash stations for safety
- Exterior access for outdoor air supply and for exhaust
- Storage of mechanical and electrical parts and materials
- Documentation storage and administrative support rooms
- Proper drainage for system maintenance
- Outlets for service maintenance utilities (e.g., water, electricity) in locations reasonably accessible to equipment operators

- Adequate lines of sight to view thermometers, pressure gages, etc.
- Structural steel elements for major maintenance rigging of equipment

Typical operator maintenance functions include cleaning of condensers, evaporators, and boiler tubes. Cooling tower catwalk safety railing and ladders should be provided to comply with U.S. Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) requirements.

9. BUILDING SYSTEM COMMISSIONING

Because a central plant consumes a major portion of the annual energy operating budget, building system commissioning is imperative for new construction and expansion of existing installations. During the warranty phase, central-plant performance should be measured, benchmarked, and course-corrected to ensure design intent is achieved. If an energy analysis study is performed as part of the comparison between decentralized and centralized concepts, the resulting month-to-month energy data should be a good electronic document to benchmark actual energy consumption using the measurement and verification plan implementation.

Ongoing commissioning or periodic recommissioning further ensures that the design intent is met, and that cooling and heating are reliably delivered after the warranty period. Many central systems are designed and built with the intent to connect to facilities in a phased program, which also requires commissioning. Consider retro- or recommissioning whenever the plant is expanded or an additional connection made to the existing systems, to ensure the original design intent is met.

It is very important to remember that all the heating and cooling is used outside of the mechanical room. Chiller and boiler commissioning will be severely limited if the engineer does not look at the coils, fans, valves, and other components that may be in other locations. Dirty coils and bypass valves can waste more energy than chiller and boiler maintenance can save.

Initial testing, adjusting, and balancing (TAB) also contributes to sustainable operation and maintenance. The TAB process should be repeated periodically to ensure original design levels are maintained.

When completing TAB and commissioning, consider posting laminated system flow diagrams at or adjacent to the central cooling and heating equipment, and include operating instructions, TAB performance, commissioning functional performance test results, and emergency shutoff procedures. These documents also should be filed electronically in the central plant computer server for quick reference.

Original basis of design and design criteria should be posted as a constant reminder of design intent, and to be readily available in case troubleshooting, expansion, or modernization is needed.

As with all HVAC applications, for maintainable, long-term operational success, building commissioning should include the system training requirements necessary for building management staff to efficiently take ownership and operate and maintain the HVAC systems over the useful service life of the installation.

10. SYSTEM REPLACEMENTS AND EXPANSIONS

More equipment is sold as replacements than for new construction. During replacements, the designer/specifier has more information available than during design (e.g., from observation and possibly operational trend logs). Typically, the difficulty is in finding the building's original design details. It is usually necessary to survey the building to determine what is installed and whether it is the same as what is represented in the original design.

The engineer also must determine if the project will be merely a replacement of existing equipment, a system expansion, or even a reduction of equipment capacity (if the original equipment was oversized). A like-for-like replacement has the advantage of simplicity, and may also not require an update of the mechanical system to current code requirements.

For a straightforward replacement, the engineer still must verify that the replacement equipment will work within the capacity, electrical, and dimensional limitations, and that it is compatible with existing the control system and other equipment.

Replacements often offer the chance to correct shortcomings of the original design, as well, such as

- Resizing when original equipment was over- or undersized (e.g., where equipment cannot handle facility loads, or where cooling systems cannot properly dehumidify the space)
- Adjusting to better fit building loads that have changed (e.g., outdated lighting has been replaced with higher-efficiency LEDs) or that were inappropriately calculated (e.g., the building needs more [or less] cooling capacity)
- Improving water and airflow rates

Other equipment (e.g., coils, towers, fans) that affect the system performance may also need replacement.

A common issue with central plants is that loads on the plant operate on different schedules. These nonsimultaneous, varied loads can introduce a low load demand on the system.

If the intent is to expand or reduce the capacity of the plant, the engineer must verify the existing equipment's operational capabilities before deciding what equipment to replace.

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CHAPTER 4

AIR HANDLING AND DISTRIBUTION

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VERY early in the design of a new or retrofit building project, the HVAC design engineer must analyze and ultimately select the basic systems, as discussed in Chapter 1, and determine whether production of primary heating and cooling should be decentralized (see Chapter 2) or central (see Chapter 3). This chapter covers the options, processes, available equipment, and challenges of **all-air systems**; for all-water, air-and-water, and local terminal systems, see Chapter 5. For additional system selection tools, refer to the *HVAC System Analysis and Selection Matrix* in ASHRAE Handbook Online (handbook.ashrae.org).

Building air systems can be designed to provide ventilation air as well as complete sensible and latent cooling, preheating, dehumidification, and humidification capacity in air supplied by the system. No additional ventilation, cooling, or humidification is then required at the zone, except for certain industrial and hospital systems. Heating may be accomplished by the same airstream, either in the central system or at a particular zone. In some applications, heating is accomplished by a separate heat source. The term *zone* implies the provision of, or the need for, separate thermostatic control, whereas the term *room* implies a partitioned area that may or may not require separate control.

The basic all-air system concept is to supply air to the room at conditions such that the sensible and latent heat gains in the space, when absorbed by supply air flowing through the space, bring the air to the desired room conditions. Because heat gains in the space vary with time, a mechanism to vary the energy removed from the space by the supply air is necessary. There are two such basic mechanisms: (1) vary the amount of supply air delivered to the space by varying the flow rate or supplying air intermittently; or (2) vary the temperature of air delivered to the space, either by modulating the temperature or conditioning the air intermittently. Both of these basic mechanisms must also accommodate variable ventilation flow rates.

All-air systems may be adapted to many applications for comfort or process work. They are used in buildings of all sizes that require individual control of multiple zones, such as office buildings, schools and universities, laboratories, hospitals, stores, hotels, and even ships. All-air systems are also used virtually exclusively in special applications for close control of temperature, humidity, ventilation, space pressure, and/or air quality classification (e.g., ISO 14644-1 Class 3 space), including cleanrooms, computer rooms, hospital operating rooms, research and development facilities, and many industrial/manufacturing facilities.

Advantages of All-Air Systems

- Operation and maintenance of major equipment can be performed in an unoccupied area (e.g., a central mechanical room). It also maximizes choices of filtration equipment, vibration and noise control, humidification and dehumidification options, and selection of high-quality and durable equipment, including enhanced filtration for returning and outdoor airstreams.
- Piping, electrical equipment, wiring, filters, and vibration- and noise-producing equipment are away from the conditioned area, minimizing (1) disruption for service needs and (2) potential harm to occupants, furnishings, and processes.
- These systems offer the greatest potential for using outdoor air for economizer cooling instead of mechanical refrigeration.
- Seasonal changeover is simple and adapts readily to automatic control.
- A wide choice of zoning, flexibility, and humidity control under all operating conditions is possible. Simultaneous heating of one zone and cooling of another zone during off-season periods is available.
- Air-to-air and other energy recovery may be readily incorporated.
- Designs are flexible for optimum air distribution, draft control, and adaptability to varying local requirements.
- The systems are well-suited to applications requiring unusual exhaust, ventilation, or makeup air quantities (negative or positive pressurization, etc.).
- All-air systems adapt well to winter humidification and dehumidification for high latent loads.
- All-air systems take advantage of load diversity. In other words, a central air-handling unit serving multiple zones needs to be sized only for the peak coincident load, not the sum of the peak loads of each individual zone. In buildings with significant fenestration loads, diversity can be significant, because the sun cannot shine on all sides of a building simultaneously.
- By increasing the air change rate and using high-quality controls, these systems can maintain the closest operating condition of ±0.15 K dry bulb and ±0.5% rh. Some systems can maintain essentially constant space conditions ideal for museums.
- Removal and disposal of cold condensate from cooling coils, and capture and return of steam condensate from heating coils, is generally simpler and more practical in an all-air system.
- Central air-handling equipment life expectancies are longer and operation and maintenance costs are less than for many terminal systems.

Disadvantages of All-Air Systems

- Ducts installed in ceiling plenums require additional duct clearance, sometimes reducing ceiling height and/or increasing building height. In retrofits, these clearances may not be available.
- Larger floor plans may be necessary to allow adequate space for vertical shafts (if required for air distribution). In a retrofit application, shafts may be impractical. Shafts, as a general rule, consume 1 to 2% of multiple-story building gross areas; for high-rise buildings, over 2% can be expected.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 9.1, Large Building Air-Conditioning Systems.

- Transport energy used by the fans to distribute air and overcome duct and equipment static resistance is a larger part of the total building's HVAC energy use than in other systems.
- In commercial buildings, air-handling equipment rooms represent nonrentable or non-revenue-generating spaces.
- Accessibility to terminal devices, duct-balancing dampers, etc., requires close cooperation between architectural, mechanical, and structural designers; therefore, accessible ceilings are recommended.
- Air balancing, particularly on large systems, can be cumbersome.
- Permanent heating is not always available sufficiently early to provide temporary heat during construction.
- Mechanical failure of a central air-handling component, such as a fan or a cooling-coil control valve, affects all zones served by that unit. Energy conservation measures implemented on any building system also may have an effect.

Heating and Cooling Calculations

Basic calculations for airflow, temperatures, relative humidity, loads, and psychrometrics are covered in Chapters 1, 17, and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. System selection should be related to the need, as indicated by the load characteristics. The designer should understand the operation of system components, their relationship to the psychrometric chart, and their interaction under various operating conditions and system configurations. The design engineer must properly determine an air-handling system's required supply air temperature and volume; outdoor ventilation air requirements; desired space pressures; heating and cooling coil capacities; humidification and dehumidification capacities; return, relief, and exhaust air volume requirements; and required pressure capabilities of the fan(s).

The HVAC designer should work closely with the architect to optimize the building envelope design. Close cooperation of all parties during an integrated design process can result in reduced building loads, which allows the use of smaller mechanical systems.

Zoning

Exterior zones are affected by weather conditions (e.g., wind, temperature, sun) and, depending on the geographic area and season, may require both heating and cooling at different times. The system must respond to these variations. The need for separate perimeter zone heating is determined by the following:

- Severity of heating load (i.e., geographic location)
- Nature and orientation of building envelope
- Effects of downdraft at windows and radiant effect of cold glass surfaces (i.e., type of glass, area, height, U-factor)
- Type of occupancy (i.e., sedentary versus transient).
- Operating costs (i.e., in buildings such as offices and schools that are unoccupied for considerable periods, fan operating cost can be reduced by heating with perimeter radiation during unoccupied periods rather than operating the main or local unit supply fans.)

Separate perimeter heating can operate with any all-air system. However, its greatest application has been in conjunction with variable-air-volume (VAV) systems for cooling-only service. Careful design must minimize simultaneous heating and cooling. See the section on Variable Air Volume for further details.

Interior spaces have relatively constant conditions because they are isolated from external influences. Cooling loads in interior zones may vary with changes in the operation of equipment and appliances in the space and changes in occupancy, but usually interior spaces require cooling throughout the year. A VAV system has limited energy advantages for interior spaces, but it does provide simple temperature control. Interior spaces with a roof exposure, however, may require treatment similar to perimeter spaces that require heat.

Space Heating

Although steam is an acceptable medium for central system preheat or reheat coils, low-temperature hot water provides a simple and more uniform means of perimeter and general space heating. Individual automatic control of each terminal provides the ideal space comfort. A control system that varies water temperature inversely with the change in outdoor temperature provides water temperatures that produce acceptable results in most applications. For best results, the most satisfactory ratio can be set after installation is completed and actual operating conditions are ascertained.

Multiple perimeter spaces on one exposure served by a central system may be heated by supplying warm air from the central system. Areas with heat gain from lights and occupants and no heat loss require cooling in winter, as well as in summer. In some systems, very little heating of return and outdoor air is required when the space is occupied. Local codes dictate the amount of outdoor air required (see ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 for recommended outdoor air ventilation). For example, with return air at 24°C and outdoor air at –18°C, the temperature of a 25% outdoor/75% return air mixture would be 12°C, which is close to the temperature of air supplied to cool such a space in summer. In this instance, a preheat coil installed in the minimum outdoor airstream to warm outdoor air can produce overheating, unless it is sized so that it does not heat the air above 2 to 7°C. Assuming good mixing, a preheat coil in the mixed airstream prevents this problem. The outdoor air damper should be kept closed until room temperatures are reached during warm-up. Low-leakage dampers should be specified and may be required by some model codes. A return air thermostat can terminate warm-up.

When a central air-handling unit supplies both perimeter and interior spaces, supply air must be cool to handle interior zones. Additional control is needed to heat perimeter spaces properly. Reheating the air is the simplest solution, but is often restricted under energy codes. An acceptable solution is to vary the volume of air to the perimeter and to combine it with a terminal heating coil or a separate perimeter heating system, either baseboard, overhead air heating, or a fan-powered terminal unit with supplemental heat. The perimeter heating should be individually controlled and integrated with the cooling control. Lowering the supply water temperature when less heat is required generally improves temperature control. For further information, refer to Chapter 13 in this volume and Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Air Temperature Versus Air Quantity

Designers have considerable flexibility in selecting supply air temperature and corresponding air quantity within the limitations of the procedures for determining heating and cooling loads. The difference between supply air temperature and desired room temperature is often referred to as the ΔT of the all-air system. The relationship between ΔT and air volume is approximately linear and inverse: doubling the ΔT results in halving of the air volume. ASHRAE *Standard* 55 addresses the effect of these variables on comfort.

The traditional all-air system is typically designed to deliver approximately 13°C supply air, for a conventional building with a desired indoor temperature of approximately 24°C. That supply air temperature is commonplace because the air is low enough in absolute moisture to result in reasonable space relative humidity in conventional buildings with modest latent heat loads. However, lower supply air temperatures may be required in spaces with high latent loads, such as gymnasiums or laundries, and higher supply air temperatures can be applied selectively with caution. Obviously, not all buildings are conventional or typical, and designers are expected not to rely on these conventions unquestioningly. (Trends toward lower lighting levels and lower internal room loads from energy-

efficient lighting mean that room sensible heat is usually lower compared to latent heat.) Commercially available load calculation software programs, when applied correctly, help the designer find the optimum supply air temperature for each application.

In cold-air systems, the supply air temperature is designed significantly lower than 13°C (perhaps as low as 7°C) in an effort to reduce the size of ducts and fans. In establishing supply air temperature, the initial cost of lower airflow and low air temperature (smaller fan and duct systems) must be calculated against potential problems of distribution, condensation, air movement, and decreased removal of odors and gaseous or particulate contaminants (Duda 2016). Terminal devices that use low-temperature air can reduce the air distribution cost. These devices mix room and primary air to maintain reasonable air movement in the occupied space, or a dual-fan dual-duct (DFDD) system that mixes air before it enters the room can be used. Because the amount of outdoor air needed is the same for any system, the percentage in low-temperature systems is high, requiring special care in design to avoid freezing preheat or cooling coils.

Duda (2016) gives the following pros and cons of using colder supply air.

Advantages.

- A greater T between supply air temperature (SAT) and desired room temperature on the air side means lower airflow to each room can achieve the same cooling effect, thereby reducing fan energy.
- Colder SAT can reduce supply air duct size, air-handling unit physical size, and (perhaps) ceiling space, saving building first cost. The reduction in duct and/or ceiling cavity size may be especially advantageous when adding ductwork to an older building with smaller floor-to-floor heights constructed before air conditioning became commonplace.
- Greater moisture removal associated with colder SAT results in lower indoor relative humidity, making it possible for the room temperature set point to be a degree or two higher without compromising occupant comfort.
- Cold SAT may be complementary to systems using ice-based or low-temperature liquid-based thermal storage.
- Lower fan airflow associated with colder SAT may lead to a quieter HVAC system.

Disadvantages.

- Cold SAT condenses more moisture at the cooling coil, meaning that a greater latent cooling load is forced onto the coil and cooling system when dehumidifying outdoor air. This can be a significant energy penalty because each kilogram of additional water vapor condensed represents an additional 2256 kJ. More latent heat removal means not only more chiller/compressor energy, but also more chilled- and condenser-water pumping energy, cooling tower fan energy (where applicable), and a higher first cost for the central cooling plant.
- Colder SAT reduces the number of hours per year that a full airside economy cycle is in effect. For example, if the SAT is 13°C and it is 13°C outdoors, the system can use 100% outdoor air without any mechanical cooling. However, if the SAT is 9°C and it is 13°C outdoors, some mechanical cooling remains necessary.
- Colder SAT increases reheat energy because it causes a lightly loaded room to overcool faster and need reheat sooner, once the VAV box reaches its minimum allowable airflow.
- Colder SAT may require colder chilled water, depending on how aggressive the cold air target is. Chillers making colder chilled water generally use more energy on a kW/kW (coefficient of performance [COP]) basis.
- Colder supply air ducts are more prone to condensation or sweating on bare sheet metal surfaces (leading to risk of mold growth) if they are not flawlessly insulated. This is of concern particularly in humid climates, on startup after setback for a night or weekend, or where there are high internal moisture loads (e.g., kitchens). If using colder SAT in these cases, specifications regarding duct insulation must be well written and thoroughly enforced. Similarly, air-handling units (AHUs) producing colder supply air may be more expensive than conventional AHUs if specifications for thermal breaks or no through-metal are needed to avoid condensation, dripping, and puddling in unconditioned or less-conditioned mechanical rooms.
- Diffuser selection can be more challenging and diffuser choices more limited, to avoid dumping cold air and to ensure a high air diffusion performance index (ADPI) in the space.
- Using cold SAT with a direct-expansion (DX) system has a greater chance of ice build-up on the DX evaporator coil due to reduced airflow per unit of refrigeration, and more moisture being condensed on the coil surface.

Space Pressure

Many special applications, such as isolation rooms, research labs, and cleanrooms, require constant-volume supply and exhaust air to the space to ensure space pressure control. Some of these applications allow the designer to reduce air volume during unoccupied periods while still maintaining space pressure control. All-air systems are generally the only systems able to combine space pressure control with temperature, humidity, and/or air filtration control.

Other Considerations

All-air systems operate by maintaining a temperature differential between the supply air and the space. Any load that affects this differential and the associated airflow must be calculated and considered, including the following:

- All **fans** (supply, return, and supplemental) add heat. All of the fan shaft power eventually converts to heat in the system, either initially as fan losses or downstream as duct friction losses. Motor inefficiencies are an added load if that motor is in the airstream. Whether the fan is upstream of the cooling coil (blow-through) or downstream (draw-though) affects how this load must be accounted for (Duda 2018a). The effect of these gains can be considerable, particularly in process applications. Heat gain in medium-pressure systems is about 1 K per kilopascal static pressure.
- The **supply duct** may gain or lose heat from the surroundings. Most energy codes require that the supply duct be insulated, which is usually good practice regardless of code requirements. Uninsulated supply ducts delivering cool air are subject to condensation formation, leading to building water damage and potential mold growth, depending on the dew-point temperature of surrounding air.
- Controlling **humidity** in a space can affect the air quantity and become the controlling factor in selecting supply airflow rate. All-air systems provide only limited humidity control, particularly at part loads, so if humidity is critical, extra care must be taken in design.

First, Operating, and Maintenance Costs

As with all systems, the initial cost of an air-handling system varies widely (even for identical systems), depending on location, condition of the local economy, and contractor preference. For example, a dual-duct system is more expensive because it requires up to twice the amount of material for ducts as that of a comparable single-duct system. Systems requiring extensive use of terminal units are also comparatively expensive. The operating cost depends on the system selected, the designer's skill in selecting and correctly

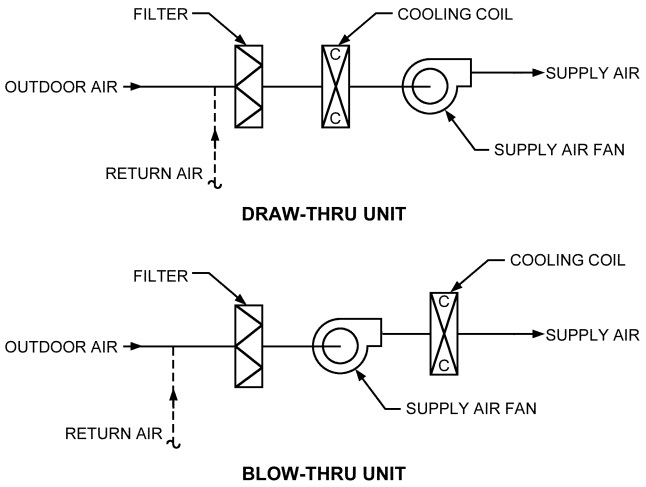

Fig. 1 Typical Air-Handling Unit Configurations

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

sizing components, efficiency of the duct design, and effect of building design and type on the operation.

Because an all-air system separates the air-handling equipment from occupied space, maintenance on major components in a central location is more economical. Also, central air-handling equipment requires less maintenance than a similar total capacity of multiple small packaged units. The many terminal units used in an all-air system do, however, require periodic maintenance. Because these units (including reheat coils) are usually installed throughout a facility, maintenance costs and scheduling for these devices must be considered.

Energy in Air Handling

The engineer's early involvement in the design of any facility can considerably affect the building's energy consumption. Careful design minimizes system energy costs. In practice, however, a system might be selected based on a low first cost or to perform a particular task. VAV systems are generally more energy efficient than constant-air-volume systems. Savings from a VAV system come from the savings in fan power and because the system does not overheat or overcool spaces, and reheat is minimized. Attention to fan static pressure settings and static pressure reset with VAV air terminal unit (ATU) unloading is needed to minimize energy use.

The air distribution system for an all-air system consists of two major subsystems: (1) air-handling units that generate conditioned air under sufficient positive pressure to circulate it to and from the conditioned space, and (2) a distribution system that only carries air from the air-handling unit to the space being conditioned. The air distribution subsystem often includes means to control the amount or temperature of air delivered to each space.

1. AIR-HANDLING UNITS

The basic air-handling system is an all-air, single-zone HVAC system consisting of an air-handling unit and an air distribution system. The air-handling unit may be designed to supply constant or variable air volume for low-, medium-, or high-velocity air distribution. Normally, the equipment is located outside the conditioned area in a basement, penthouse, or service area. The equipment can be adjacent to the primary heating and refrigeration equipment or at considerable distance, with refrigerant, chilled water, hot water, or steam circulated to it for energy transfer.

Figure 1 shows a typical draw-through central system that supplies conditioned air to a single zone or to multiple zones. A blow-through configuration may also be used if space or other conditions dictate. The quantity and quality of supplied air are fixed by space requirements and determined as indicated in Chapters 17 and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Air gains and loses heat by contacting heat transfer surfaces and by mixing with air of another condition. Some of this mixing is intentional, as at the outdoor air intake; other mixing results from the physical characteristics of a particular component, as when untreated air passes through a coil without contacting the fins (bypass factor).

All treated and untreated air must be well mixed for maximum performance of heat transfer surfaces and for uniform temperatures in the airstream. Stratified, parallel paths of treated and untreated air must be avoided, particularly in the vertical plane of systems using double-inlet or multiple-wheel fans. Because these fans may not completely mix the air, different temperatures can occur in branches coming from opposite sides of the supply duct. Poor mixing in units with high outdoor percentages can also result in freezing temperatures at the coils. Single or dual plenum fans can improve mixing conditions as well as reduce space requirements between upstream or downstream unit coils.

Primary Equipment

Cooling. Either central station or localized equipment, depending on the application, can provide cooling. Most large systems with multiple central air-handling units use a central refrigeration plant. Small, individual air-handling equipment can (1) be supplied with chilled water from central chillers, (2) use direct-expansion cooling with a central condensing (cooling tower) system, or (3) be air cooled and totally self-contained. The decision to provide a central plant or local equipment is based on factors similar to those for air-handling equipment, and is further addressed in Chapters 1 to 3.

Heating. The same criteria described for cooling are usually used to determine whether a central heating plant or a local one is desirable. Usually, a central, fuel-fired plant is more desirable for heating large facilities. In facilities with low heating loads, electric heating is a viable option and is often economical, particularly where care has been taken to design energy-efficient systems and buildings. Another option is a local indirect fuel-fired furnace in an air-handling unit.

Air-Handling Equipment

Packaged air-handling equipment is commercially available in many sizes, capacities, and configurations using any desired method of cooling, heating, humidification, filtration, etc. These systems can be suitable for small and large buildings. In large systems (over 25 m^3/s), air-handling equipment is usually custom-designed and fabricated to suit a particular application. Air-handling units may be either centrally or remotely located.

Air-handling units (AHUs) can be one of the more complicated pieces of equipment to specify or order, because a vast array of choices are available, and because there is no single-number identifier (e.g., a "200 kW unit" or a "20 m^3/s unit") that adequately describes the desired product. Regardless of size or type, the designer must properly determine an air-handling unit's required supply air temperature and volume; outdoor air requirements; desired space pressures; heating and cooling coil capacities; humidification and dehumidification capacities; return, relief, and exhaust air volume requirements; filtration; and required pressure capabilities of the fan(s). Typically, these parameters and more must be specified or scheduled by the design engineer before an installer or equipment supplier can provide an AHU.

Central Mechanical Equipment Rooms (MERs)

The type of facility and other factors help determine where the air-handling equipment is located. Central fan rooms are more common in large buildings, where maintenance is isolated from the conditioned space. The advent of fan arrays and increased cost competitiveness in the custom AHU market have led to very large air-handling units (**mega-AHUs**) designed for over 50,000 L/s (Taylor 2018). Reasons a design engineer may consider a central air-handling unit or bank of central air-handling units include the following:

- Fewer total pieces of equipment to maintain.
- Maintenance is concentrated at one location.
- Filtration is easily enhanced.
- Energy recovery opportunities may be more practical.
- Compared to floor-by-floor AHUs, very large AHUs with fan arrays are less expensive, require less space, have lower maintenance costs, and generally are more energy efficient.
- Vibration and noise control, seismic bracing, outdoor air intakes, economizers, filtration, humidification, and similar auxiliary factors may be handled more simply when equipment is centralized.

Decentralized MERs

Many buildings locate air-handling equipment at each floor, or at other logical subdivisions of a facility. Reasons a design engineer may consider multiple distributed air-handling unit locations include the following:

- Reduced size of ducts reduces space required for distribution ductwork and shafts.
- Reduced equipment size as a result of decentralized systems allows use of less expensive packaged equipment and reduces the necessary sophistication of training for operating and maintenance personnel.
- For facilities with varied occupancy, multiple decentralized air-handling units can be set back or turned off in unoccupied areas.
- Failure of an air-handling unit affects only the part of the building served by that one unit.
- Having greater quantity of smaller AHUs is well suited to buildings with multiple tenants who may have varying start times, or if rogue zones cause duct static pressure and supply air temperature reset strategies to be ineffective.

Fans

Both packaged and built-up air-handling units can use any type of fan. Centrifugal fans may be forward-curved, backward-inclined, or airfoil, and single-width/single-inlet (SWSI) or double-width/double-inlet (DWDI). Many packaged air-handling units feature a single fan, but packaged and custom air-handling units can use multiple DWDI centrifugal fans on a common shaft with a single drive motor. SWSI centrifugal plenum (plug) fans without a scroll are common on larger packaged air-handling units to make them more compact. Also, direct-drive fans are common with variable-frequency drives, thus avoiding belt maintenance and replacement. Fan selection should be based on efficiency and sound power level throughout the anticipated range of operation, as well as on the ability of the fan to provide the required flow at the anticipated static pressure. Chapter 21 further discusses fans and fan selection.

1.1 AIR-HANDLING UNIT PSYCHROMETRIC PROCESSES

Cooling

The basic methods used for cooling and dehumidification include the following:

- **Direct expansion** (refrigerant) takes advantage of the latent heat of the refrigerant fluid, and cools as shown in the psychrometric diagram in Figure 2.
- **Chilled-water** (fluid-filled) coils use temperature differences between the fluid and air to exchange energy by the same process as in Figure 2 (see the section on Dehumidification).
- **Direct spray of water in the airstream** (Figure 3), an adiabatic process, uses the latent heat of evaporation of water to reduce dry-bulb temperature while increasing moisture content. Both sensible and latent cooling are also possible by using chilled water. A conventional evaporative cooler uses the adiabatic process by spraying or dripping recirculated water onto a filter pad (see the section on Humidification).
- The **wetted duct** or **supersaturated** system is a variation of direct spray. In this system, tiny droplets of free moisture are carried by the air into the conditioned space, where they evaporate and provide additional cooling, reducing the amount of air needed for cooling the space (Figure 4).
- **Indirect evaporation** adiabatically cools outdoor or exhaust air from the conditioned space by spraying water, then passes that cooled air through one side of a heat exchanger. Air to be supplied to the space is cooled by passing through the other side of the heat exchanger. Chapter 41 has further information on this method of cooling.

Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* details the psychrometric processes of these methods.

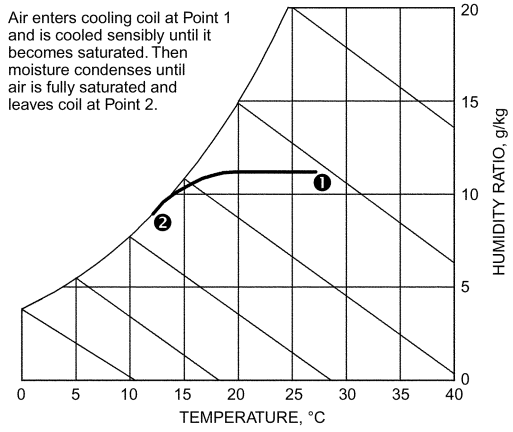

Fig. 2 Direct-Expansion or Chilled-Water Cooling and Dehumidification

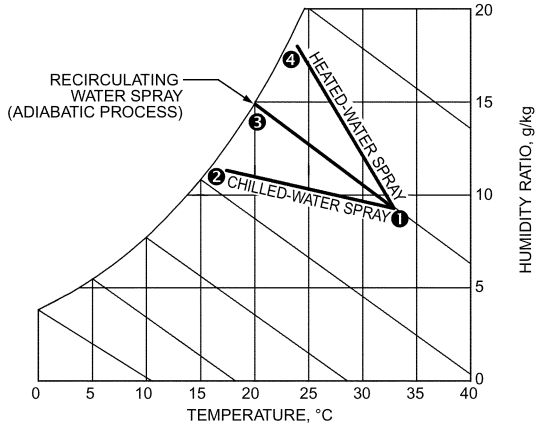

Fig. 3 Direct Spray of Water in Airstream Cooling

Heating

The basic methods used for heating include the following:

- **Steam** uses the latent heat of the fluid.
- **Hot-water** (fluid-filled) coils use temperature differences between the warm fluid and the cooler air.
- **Electric heat** also uses the temperature difference between the heating coil and the air to exchange energy.
- **Direct or indirect gas- or oil-fired heat exchangers** can also be used to add sensible heat to the airstream.

The effect on the airstream for each of these processes is the same and is shown in Figure 5. For basic equations, see Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Humidification

Methods used to humidify air include the following:

- **Direct spray of recirculated water** into the airstream (air washer) reduces the dry-bulb temperature while maintaining an almost constant wet bulb, in an adiabatic process (see Figure 3, path 1 to 3). The air may also be cooled and dehumidified, or heated and humidified, by changing the spray water temperature.

  In one variation, the surface area of water exposed to the air is increased by spraying water onto a cooling/heating coil. The coil surface temperature determines leaving air conditions. Another method is to spray or distribute water over a porous medium, such as those in evaporative coolers. This method requires careful monitoring of the water condition to keep biological contaminants from the airstream (Figure 6).
- **Compressed air** that forces water through a nozzle into the airstream is essentially a constant wet-bulb (adiabatic) process. The water must be treated to keep particles from entering the airstream and contaminating or coating equipment and furnishings. Many types of nozzles are available.
- **Steam injection** is a constant-dry-bulb process (Figure 7). As the steam injected becomes superheated, the leaving dry-bulb temperature increases. If live steam is injected into the airstream, the boiler water treatment chemical must be nontoxic to occupants and nondamaging to building interior and furnishings.

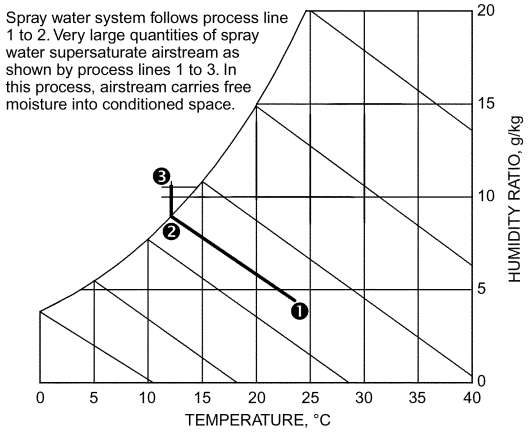

Fig. 4 Supersaturated Evaporative Cooling

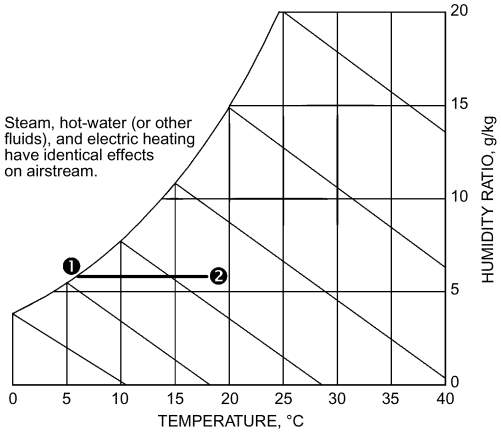

Fig. 5 Steam, Hot-Water, and Electric Heating, and Direct and Indirect Gas- and Oil-Fired Heat Exchangers

Dehumidification

Moisture condenses on a cooling coil when its surface temperature is below the air's dew point, thus reducing the humidity of the air. Similarly, air will also be dehumidified if a fluid with a temperature below the airstream dew point is sprayed into the airstream (see the section on Air Washers in Chapter 41). The process is identical to that shown in Figure 2, except that the moisture condensed from the airstream condenses on, and dissolves in, the spray droplets instead of on the solid coil surface.

Chemical dehumidification involves either passing air over a solid desiccant or spraying the air with a solution of desiccant and water. Both of these processes add heat, often called the **latent heat of wetting**, to the air being dehumidified. Usually about 465 kJ/kg of moisture is removed (Figure 8). These systems should be

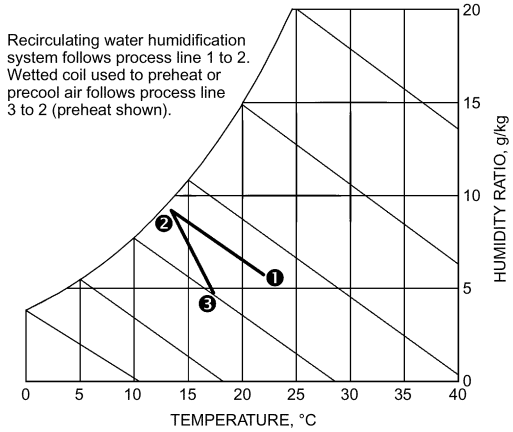

Fig. 6 Direct Spray Humidification

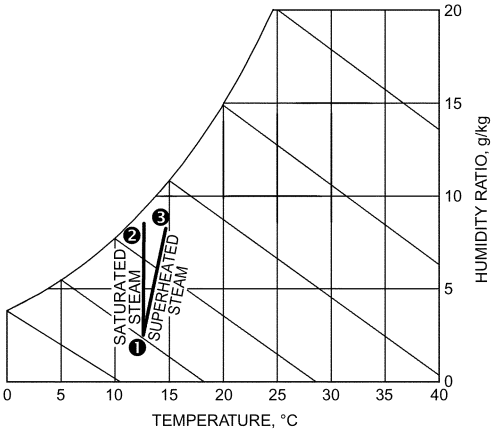

Fig. 7 Steam Injection Humidification

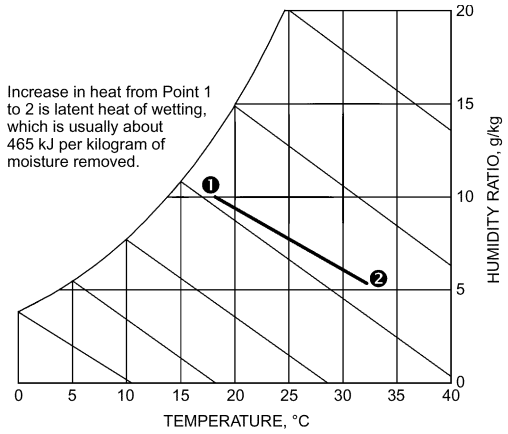

Fig. 8 Chemical Dehumidification

reviewed with the user to ensure that the space is not contaminated. Chapter 24 has more information on this topic.

Air Mixing or Blending

Adiabatic mixing of two or more airstreams (e.g., outdoor and return air) into a common airstream can be shown on a psychrometric chart with reasonable accuracy (see Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*).

1.2 AIR-HANDLING UNIT COMPONENTS

The following sections describe many commonly available air-handling unit components. Not all of these components will necessarily be used in any one system.

To determine the system's air-handling requirement, the designer must consider the function and physical characteristics of the space to be conditioned, and the air volume and thermal exchange capacities required. Then, the various components may be selected and arranged by considering the fundamental requirements of the central system.

Figure 1 shows two basic arrangements of air-handling unit components for a single-zone, all-air central system suitable for year-round air conditioning. These arrangements allow close control of temperature and humidity. Most of the components in Figure 1 are available from many manufacturers completely assembled or in subassembled sections that can be bolted together in the field. When selecting central system components, specific design parameters must be evaluated to balance cost, controllability, operating expense, maintenance, noise, and space. The sizing and selection of primary air-handling units substantially affect the results obtained in the conditioned space.

The equipment must be adequate, accessible for easy maintenance, and not overly complex in its arrangement and control to provide the required conditions. Further, the designer should consider economics in component selection. Both initial and operating costs affect design decisions. For example, the designer should not arbitrarily design for a 2.5 m/s face velocity, which has been common for selecting cooling coils and other components. Filter and coil selection at 1.5 to 2 m/s, with resultant lower pressure loss, could produce a substantial payback on constant-volume systems (Peterson 2014). Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* has further information on energy and life-cycle costs.

Return Air Fan

A return air fan is optional on small systems, but is essential for proper operation of air economizer systems for free cooling from outdoor air if the return path has a significant pressure drop (greater than approximately 75 Pa). It provides a positive return and exhaust from the conditioned area, particularly when mixing dampers allow cooling with outdoor air in intermediate seasons and winter. The return air fan ensures that the proper volume of air returns from the conditioned space. It prevents excess building pressure when economizer cycles introduce more than the minimum quantity of outdoor air, and reduces the static pressure against which the supply fan must work. The return air fan should handle a slightly smaller amount of air to account for fixed exhaust systems, such as toilet exhaust, and to ensure a slight positive pressure in the conditioned space. Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* provides design details; also, see ASHRAE *Guideline* 16 and Taylor (2014).

Relief Air Fan

In many situations, a relief (or exhaust) air fan may be used instead of a return fan. A relief air fan relieves ventilation air introduced during air economizer operation and operates only when this control cycle is in effect. When a relief air fan is used, the supply fan must be designed for the total supply and return pressure losses in the system. During economizer mode, the relief fan must be controlled to ensure a slight positive pressure in the conditioned space, as with the return air fan system. The section on Economizers describes the required control for relief air fans.

Automatic Dampers

The section on Mixing Plenums discusses conditions that must be considered when choosing, sizing, and locating automatic dampers for this critical mixing process. These dampers throttle the air with parallel- or opposed-blade rotation. These two forms of dampers have different airflow throttling characteristics (see Chapter 7 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). Pressure relationships between various sections of this mixing process must be considered to ensure that automatic dampers are properly sized for wide-open and modulating pressure drops. See ASHRAE *Guideline* 16 for additional detail.

Relief Openings

Relief openings in large buildings should be constructed similarly to outdoor air intakes, but may require motorized or self-acting backdraft dampers to prevent high wind pressure or stack action from causing airflow to reverse when the automatic dampers are open. Pressure loss through relief openings should be 25 Pa or less. Low-leakage dampers, such as those for outdoor intakes, prevent rattling and minimize leakage. The relief air opening should be located so that air does not short-circuit to the outdoor air intake. Damper relief openings may also be used in conjunction with area pressure control.

Return Air Dampers

Negative pressure in the outdoor air intake plenum is a function of the resistance or static pressure loss through the outdoor air louvers, damper, and duct. Positive pressure in the relief air plenum is likewise a function of the static pressure loss through the relief damper, the relief duct between the plenum and outdoors, and the relief louver. The pressure drop through the return air damper must accommodate the pressure difference between the positive-pressure relief air plenum and the negative-pressure outdoor air plenum. Proper sizing of this damper facilitates better control and mixing. An additional manual damper may be required for proper air balancing.

Outdoor Air Intakes

Resistance through outdoor air intakes varies widely, depending on construction. Frequently, architectural considerations dictate the type and style of louver. The designer should ensure that the louvers

selected offer minimum pressure loss, preferably not more than 25 Pa. High-efficiency, low-pressure louvers that effectively limit carryover of rain are available. Flashing installed at the outer wall and weep holes or a floor drain will carry away rain and melted snow entering the intake. Cold regions may require a snow baffle to direct fine snow to a low-velocity area below the dampers. Outdoor air dampers should be low-leakage types with special gasketed edges and endseals. A separate damper section and damper operator are strongly recommended for ensuring minimum ventilation. The maximum outdoor air damper controls the air needed for economizer cycles.

Carefully consider the location of intake and exhaust louvers; in some jurisdictions, location is governed by codes. Louvers must be separated enough to avoid short-circuiting air. Furthermore, intake louvers should not be near a potential source of contaminated air, such as a boiler stack or hood exhaust from a kitchen, laundry, or laboratory. Relief air should also not interfere with other systems. If heat recovery devices are used, intake and exhaust airstreams may need to be run in parallel, such as through air-to-air heat exchangers.

A past complaint was a lack of outdoor air, especially in VAV systems where outdoor air quantities were established for peak loads and were then reduced in proportion to the air supplied during periods of reduced load. A simple airflow measurement control scheme added to the outdoor air damper eliminates this problem and keeps the amount of outdoor air constant, regardless of VAV system operation. However, the need to preheat outdoor air must be considered.

Economizers

An air-side economizer uses outdoor air to reduce refrigeration requirements. Whereas a logic circuit maintains a fixed minimum of ventilation outdoor air in all weather, the air-side economizer takes advantage of cool outdoor air either to assist mechanical cooling or, if outdoor air is cool enough, to provide total system cooling. When weather allows, temperature controls systems can modulate outdoor and return air in the correct proportion to produce desired supply air temperatures without mechanical heating or cooling. For example, if 13°C supply air is necessary for space cooling and it is 13°C outdoors, direct digital controls (DDC) will position dampers to use 100% outdoor air without mechanical heating or cooling. If the return air is 24°C and it is 2°C outdoors, a 50/50 blend of return and outdoor air will produce 13°C supply air, again without mechanical heating or cooling.

Designers should evaluate drying of the conditioned space when using economizers; exceptionally dry conditions may require mechanical humidification, which may reduce the attractiveness of air-side economizers.

To exhaust the extra outdoor air brought in by the economizer, a method of variable-volume relief must be provided. The relief volume may be controlled by modulating the relief air dampers in response to building space pressure. Another common approach is opening the relief/exhaust and outdoor air intake dampers simultaneously, although this alone does not address space pressurization. A powered relief or return/relief fan may also be used. The relief system is off and relief dampers are closed when the air-side economizer is inactive. Intake dampers must be low leakage.

Advantages and disadvantages of air-side economizers are discussed in Chapter 2.

Mixing Plenums

Mixing plenums provide space for airstreams with different properties to mix as they are introduced into a common section of ductwork or air-handling unit, allowing the system to operate as intended. If the airstreams are not sufficiently mixed, the resulting stratification adversely affects system performance. Some problems associated with stratification are nuisance low-temperature safety cutouts, frozen cooling coils, excess energy use by the preheat coil, inadequate outdoor air, control hunting, and poor outdoor air distribution throughout occupied spaces.

A common example of a mixing plenum is the air-handling unit mixing box, in which outdoor and recirculated airstreams are combined. In air-handling units, mixing boxes typically have one inlet, with control dampers, for each airstream.

There are no performance standards for mixing boxes or mixing plenums. Thus, it is difficult to know whether a particular mixing box design will provide sufficient mixing. In the absence of performance data, many rules of thumb have been developed to increase the mixing provided by mixing boxes. It is important to note that few supporting data exist; the following suggestions are based largely on common-sense solutions and anecdotal evidence:

- The minimum outdoor air damper should be located as close as possible to the return air damper.
- An outdoor air damper sized for 7.5 m/s gives good control.
- Low-leakage outdoor air dampers minimize leakage during system shutdown.
- A higher velocity through the return air damper facilitates air balance and may increase mixing.
- Parallel-blade dampers may aid mixing. Positioning the dampers so that the return and outdoor airstreams are deflected toward each other may increase mixing.
- Placing the outdoor air damper above the return air damper increases mixing by density differences: denser, cold outdoor air mixes as it drops through the warm, less dense return air.
- Mixing dampers should be placed across the full width of the unit, even if the location of the return duct makes it more convenient to return air through the side. Return air entering through the side of an air-handling unit can pass through one side of a double-inlet fan while outdoor air passes through the other side. This same situation can exist whenever two parallel fans are used in an air-handling unit receiving two different airstreams. Wherever there are two fans and two airstreams, an air mixer should be used.
- Field-built baffles may be used to create additional turbulence and to enhance mixing. Unfortunately, the mixing effectiveness and pressure drop of field-built solutions are unknown.

If stratification is anticipated in a system, then special mixing equipment that has been tested by the manufacturer (see the section on Static Air Mixers) should be specified and used in the air-handling system.

Static Air Mixers

Static air mixers are designed to enhance mixing in the mixing plenum to reduce or eliminate problems associated with stratification. These devices have no moving parts and create turbulence in the airstream, which increases mixing. They are usually mounted between the mixing box and the heating or cooling coil; the space required depends on the amount of mixing that is required. Typical pressure loss for these devices is 25 to 75 Pa.

There are no performance standards for air mixers. Thus, manufacturers of air mixers and air-handling units should demonstrate that their devices provide adequate mixing.

Filter Section

A system's overall performance depends heavily on the filter. Unless the filter is regularly maintained, system resistance increases and airflow diminishes. Accessibility for replacement is an important consideration in filter arrangement and location. In smaller air-handling units, filters are often placed in a slide-out rack for side-access replacement. In larger units and built-up systems with internal or front-loading access, there should be at least 1 m between the upstream face of the filter bank and any obstruc-

tion. Other requirements for filters can be found in Chapter 29 and in ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2.

Good mixing of outdoor and return air is also necessary for good filter performance. A poorly placed outdoor air duct or a bad duct connection to the mixing plenum can cause uneven filter loading and poor distribution of air through the coil section.

Particulate filters are rated according to ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2's minimum efficiency rating value (MERV) system, a numeric ranking from 1 (least) to 20 (highest). A particulate filter bank of at least MERV 6 should be placed upstream of the first coil, to maintain coil cleanliness. Depending on the spaces served, many applications demand higher-efficiency filters. Some studies suggest filters up to MERV 14 can pay for themselves in reduced coil maintenance and better heat transfer effectiveness. Where higher-MERV filters are used, many designers specify a lower-MERV prefilter as an inexpensive sacrificial filter to capture bulk particulate and extend the life of the more expensive final filter.

Filter bank(s) location may be governed by codes. For example, many prevailing health care codes mandate a prefilter upstream of all fans, coils, and humidifiers, plus a final filter bank downstream of all fans, coils, and humidifiers.

Designers are not limited to particulate filters. Electronic air cleaners and gaseous-phase (e.g., activated carbon) filters are available for added protection. For example, ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 requires use of gaseous-phase filters for certain, usually urban, regions where outdoor air quality has been measured to exceed threshold values for ozone or other gaseous contaminants. Odor control using activated carbon or potassium permanganate as a filter medium is also available. Chapters 11 and 12 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* have more information on odor control.

Preheat Coil

Preheat coils are heating coils placed upstream of a cooling coil; they can use steam, hot water, or electric resistance as a medium. Some air-handling units do not require a preheat coil at all, particularly if the percentage of outdoor air is low and if building heating is provided elsewhere (e.g., perimeter baseboard). Where used, a preheat coil should have wide fin spacing, be accessible for easy cleaning, and be protected by filters. If a preheat coil is located in the minimum outdoor airstream rather than in the mixed airstream as shown in Figure 11, it should not heat the air to an exit temperature above 2 to 7°C; preferably, it should become inoperative at outdoor temperatures above 7°C. For use with steam, inner distributing tube or integral face-and-bypass coils are preferable. Hot-water preheat coils should be piped for counterflow so that the coldest air contacts the warmest part of the coil surface first. Consider a constant-flow recirculating pump if the local climate and anticipated percentage of outdoor air may result in freezing conditions at a hot-water preheat coil. Chapter 27 provides more detailed information on heating coils.

Cooling Coil

Sensible and latent heat are removed from the air by the cooling coils. The cooling medium can be either chilled water or refrigerant, in which case the refrigerant coil serves as the evaporator in a vapor-compression refrigeration cycle. The psychrometrics of cooling and dehumidification were described previously.

In all finned coils, some air passes through without contacting the fins or tubes. The amount of this bypass can vary from 30% for a four-row coil at 3.5 m/s, to less than 2% for an eight-row coil at 1.5 m/s. The dew point of the air mixture leaving a four-row coil might satisfy a comfort installation with 25% or less outdoor air (10% for humid climates), a small internal latent load, and sensible temperature control only. For close control of room conditions for precision work, a deeper coil may be required. Chapter 23 provides more information on cooling coils and their selection.

Coil freezing can be a serious problem with chilled-water coils. Full-flow circulation of chilled water during freezing weather, or even reduced flow with a small recirculating pump, minimizes coil freezing and eliminates stratification. Further, continuous full-flow circulation can provide a source of off-season chilled water in air-and-water systems. Antifreeze solutions or complete coil draining also prevent coil freezing. However, because it is difficult (if not impossible) to drain most cooling coils completely, caution should be used if this option is considered.

Another design consideration is the drain pan. ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 calls for drain pans to be sloped to a drain, to avoid holding standing water in the air-handling unit. Because of the constant presence of moisture in the cooling coil drain pan and nearby casing, many designers require stainless steel construction in that portion of the air-handling unit.

Reheat Coil

Reheat coils are heating coils placed downstream of a cooling coil. Reheat systems are strongly discouraged, unless recovered energy is used (see ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1). Positive humidity control is required to provide comfort conditions for most occupancies. Either reheat or desiccant is usually required to dehumidify outdoor air. Reheating is necessary for laboratory, health care, or similar applications where temperature and relative humidity must be controlled accurately. Heating coils located in the reheat position, as shown in Figure 11, are frequently used for warm-up, although a coil in the preheat position is preferable. Hot-water coils provide a very controllable source of reheat energy. Inner-distributing-tube coils are preferable for steam applications. Electric coils may also be used. See Chapter 27 for more information.

Reheat is highly inefficient. In health care occupancies, many spaces have total air turnover requirements, which, in concert with the apparatus dew-point temperature required for humidity control in the space, often results in reheat to avoid space overcooling. Coil-bypass air handling avoids most of the required reheat through a strategy described by Nall (2017). Properly controlled to maintain the required operating parameters, this strategy can significantly reduce required cooling and heating capacity, and thus first cost, as well as save significant annual energy costs. However, close attention is needed to the override strategies to prevent supply air temperature optimization algorithms from compromising the required space operating conditions.

Humidifiers

Humidifiers may be installed as part of the air-handling unit, or in terminals at the point of use, or both. Where close humidity control of selected spaces is required, the entire supply airstream may be humidified to a low humidity level in the air-handling unit. Terminal humidifiers in the supply ducts serving selected spaces bring humidity up to the required levels. For comfort installations not requiring close control, moisture can be added to the air by mechanical atomizers or point-of-use electric or ultrasonic humidifiers.

Steam grid humidifiers with dew-point control usually are used for accurate humidity control. Air to a laboratory or other space that requires close humidity control must be reheated after leaving a cooling coil before moisture can be added. Humidifying equipment capacity should not exceed the expected peak load by more than 10%. If humidity is controlled from the room or return air, a limiting humidistat and fan interlock may be needed in the supply duct. This tends to minimize condensation and mold or mildew growth in the ductwork. Humidifiers add some sensible heat that should be accounted for in the psychrometric evaluation. See Chapter 22 for additional information.

An important question for air-handling unit specifiers is where to place the humidification grid. Moisture cannot be successfully added to cold air, so placement is typically downstream of a preheat

coil. For general building humidification, one satisfactory location is between a preheat coil and cooling coil.

Another consideration is absorption distance (i.e., distance required for steam to be absorbed into the airstream). This can vary from 450 mm to 1.5 m and must be allowed for in the layout and dimensioning of the air-handling unit.

Dehumidifiers

For most routine applications in dry or limited-cooling climates, such as offices, residences, and schools, the air-handling unit's cooling coil provides adequate dehumidification. For humid climates, separate dehumidifiers or some form of reheat or desiccant is usually necessary. Where a specialty application requires additional moisture removal, desiccant dehumidifiers are an available accessory. Dust can be a problem with solid desiccants, and lithium contamination is a concern with spray equipment. Chapter 23 discusses dehumidification by cooling coils, and Chapter 24 discusses desiccant dehumidifiers.

Energy Recovery Devices

Energy recovery devices are in greater demand as outdoor air percentage increases along with increasing HVAC efficiency requirements. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 requires energy recovery devices for air-handling units except for systems with low outdoor air percentages or very low overall capacity. They are used extensively in research and development facilities and in hospitals and laboratories with high outdoor air requirements. Many types are available, and the type of facility usually determines which is most suitable. Choices include heat pipes, runaround loops, fixed-plate energy exchangers (both sensible only and enthalpic), and rotary wheel energy exchangers. See Chapter 26 for details. Select these devices with care, and minimize the differential pressure between airstreams.

Most manufacturers of factory-packaged air-handling units offer optional energy recovery modules for both small and large unit applications. Many countries with extreme climates provide heat exchangers on outdoor/relief air, even for private homes. This trend is now appearing in both modest and large commercial buildings worldwide. Under certain circumstances, heat recovery devices can save energy and reduce the required capacity of primary cooling and heating plants by 20% or more.

When applying energy recovery, it is important to have a way to bypass or disable the energy recovery in mild weather. Under some outdoor conditions, an energy recovery device can actually increase energy use. For example, if an air-handling unit is set to provide 13°C supply air, the exhaust is 24°C, and the outdoor temperature is 13°C, an energy recovery device will warm the supply air (via the 24°C exhaust) and then require mechanical cooling to return it to 13°C. An energy recovery device is an excellent choice during very hot or very cold weather, but not during mild weather. A rotating enthalpy wheel can be turned off when necessary. For a fixed-plate heat exchanger, an outdoor-air bypass around the heat exchanger is needed, with motorized dampers and control logic to use the recovery device only when advantageous to do so.

Another important consideration is whether to size AHU heating and/or cooling coils as if the energy recovery device has failed and is no longer recovering energy, especially for rotary wheel energy recovery devices whose motor or drive could possibly fail, with potentially significant negative consequences on a very hot/humid or very cold day. Doing so allows such a failure to be ridden through without loss of building temperature control. However, there is some additional pressure loss of the upsized heating and/or cooling coil for the 99% (or more) of the time that the energy recovery device is in good working order. The engineer, in consultation with the building users, should apply judgment based on the critical nature of the building (e.g., hospital versus office), consequences of a failure (e.g., loss of rental income), etc. In colder climates, for example, many designers size the heating coil (but not the cooling coil) as if the energy recovery device has failed, on the assumption that occupants and property need to be protected from the cold more so than from heat. Many designers do not apply this safety consideration when applying static energy recovery devices with no moving parts, reasoning that the likelihood of failure is extremely low.

For more information on technical considerations beyond this chapter's scope, see Chapter 26.

Sound Control Devices

Where noise control is important, air-handling units can be specified with a noise control section, ranging from a plenum lined with acoustic duct liner to a full bank of duct silencers. This option is available in the smallest to largest units. Sound attenuation can be designed into the discharge (supply) end of the air-handling unit to reduce ductborne fan noise. Remember to consider ductborne noise traveling backward down the return or outdoor air paths in a noise-sensitive application, and use a sound attenuation module if necessary at the inlet end of an air-handling unit. See Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for details.

Supply Air Fan

Axial-flow, centrifugal, or plenum (plug) fans may be chosen as supply air fans for straight-through flow applications. In factory-fabricated units, more than one centrifugal fan may be tied to the same shaft. If headroom allows, use a single-inlet fan when air enters at right angles to the flow of air through the equipment. This allows direct airflow from the fan wheel into the supply duct without abrupt change in direction and loss of efficiency. It also allows a more gradual transition from the fan to the duct and increases static regain in the velocity pressure conversion. To minimize inlet losses, the distance between casing walls and fan inlet should be at least the diameter of the fan wheel. With a single-inlet fan, the length of the transition section should be at least half the width or height of the casing, whichever is longer. If fans blow through the equipment, analyze air distribution through the downstream components, and use baffles to ensure uniform air distribution. See Chapter 21 for more information.

Two placements of the supply fan section are common. A supply fan placed downstream of the cooling coil is known as a draw-through arrangement, because air is drawn, or induced, across the cooling coil. Similarly, a supply fan placed upstream of the cooling coil is called the blow-through position. Either arrangement is possible in both small and large air-handling units, and in factory-packaged and custom field-erected units.

A **draw-through system** (illustrated in Figure 1) draws air across the coils. A draw-through system usually provides a more even air distribution over all parts of the coil. However, some fan heat is added to the airstream after the air has crossed the cooling coil and must be taken into account when calculating the desired supply air temperature. Depressing the cooling coil's leaving air temperature an equivalent amount to account for fan heat, may accidentally add additional latent load to the system because depressing the coil leaving temperature if in an already saturated condition strips additional moisture from the airstream. In other words, a draw-through arrangement has a higher dehumidification (latent cooling) effect for a given leaving air temperature. If a typical cooling coil drops the wet-bulb temperature 6 K and the motor heat rise is 2 K, then the latent cooling is 6 – 2 = 4 K. This can help with applications that need higher dehumidification levels.

A **blow-through system** (illustrated in Figure 1) requires some caution on the part of the designer, because the blast effect of the supply fan outlet can concentrate a high percentage of the total air over a small percentage of the downstream coil surfaces. Air diffusers or diverters may be required. Consequently, blow-through air-handling

units may tend to be longer overall than comparable draw-through units. Now that plenum fans and plenum fan arrays have become more common, their air discharge pattern tends to be much more uniform, somewhat mitigating this concern. This arrangement offers the advantage of placing the fan before the cooling coil, raising the temperature of air before it enters the cooling coil and thereby allowing the cooling coil to remove fan heat from the system. The added heat is entirely sensible and therefore typically less than the sensible-plus-latent penalty discussed for draw-through. The blow-through arrangement is mandatory where natural-gas-fired heat exchangers are used for heating.

In either arrangement, consider the system effect of the fan arrangement in the unit. Refer to AMCA *Standard* 210/ASHRAE *Standard* 51 for details.

Miscellaneous Components

Vibration and sound isolation equipment is required for many central fan installations. Standard mountings of fiberglass, ribbed rubber, neoprene mounts, and springs are available for most fans and prefabricated units. The designer must account for seismic restraint requirements for the seismic zone in which the project is located (see Chapter 56 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*). In some applications, fans may require concrete inertia blocks in addition to spring mountings. Steel springs require sound-absorbing material inserted between the springs and the foundation. Horizontal discharge fans operating at a high static pressure frequently require thrust arrestors. Ductwork connections to fans should be made with fireproof fiber cloth sleeves having considerable slack, but without offset between the fan outlet and rigid duct. Misalignment between the duct and fan outlet can cause turbulence, generate noise, and reduce system efficiency. Electrical and piping connections to vibration-isolated equipment should be made with flexible conduit and flexible connections.

Equipment noise transmitted through ductwork can be reduced by sound-absorbing units, acoustical lining, and other means of attenuation. Sound transmitted through the return and relief ducts should not be overlooked. Acoustical lining sufficient to adequately attenuate objectionable system noise or locally generated noise should be considered. Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* and Chapter 8 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Hand-book—Fundamentals* have further information on sound and vibration control. Noise control, both in occupied spaces and outdoors near intake or relief louvers, must be considered. Some local ordinances may limit external noise produced by these devices.

1.3 AIR DISTRIBUTION

Once air-handling system and air-handling equipment have been selected, air must be distributed to the zone(s) served. Ductwork should deliver conditioned air to each zone as directly, quietly, and economically as possible. Air distribution ductwork and terminal devices must be compatible; otherwise, the system will either fail to operate effectively or incur high first, operating, and maintenance costs. Unit connections must be given close attention; see AMCA *Standard* 210/ASHRAE *Standard* 51 for details.

Ductwork Design

Chapter 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describes ductwork design in detail and gives several methods of sizing duct systems, including static regain and equal friction. Duct sizing is often performed manually for simple systems, but commercially available duct-sizing software programs are often used for larger and complex systems. It is imperative that the designer coordinate duct design with architectural and structural design. Structural features of the building generally require some compromise and often limit depth. In commercially developed projects, great effort is made to reduce floor-to-floor dimensions. In architecturally significant buildings, high ceilings, barrel-vault ceilings, rotundas and domes, ceiling coves, and other architectural details can place obstacles in the path of ductwork. The resultant decrease in available interstitial space left for ductwork can be a major design challenge. Layout of ductwork in these buildings requires experience, skill, and patience on the part of the designer.

Considerations. Duct systems can be designed for high or low velocity. A high-velocity system has smaller ducts, which save space but require higher pressures and may result in more noise. In some low-velocity systems, medium or high fan pressures may be required for balancing or to overcome high pressure drops from terminal devices. In any variable-flow system, changing operating conditions can cause airflow in the ducts to differ from design flow. Thus, varying airflow in the supply duct must be carefully analyzed to ensure that the system performs efficiently at all loads. This precaution is particularly needed with high-velocity air. Return air ducts are usually sized by the equal friction method. ASHRAE is currently developing a ductwork design manual, scheduled for publication in late 2016.

In many applications, the space between a suspended ceiling and the floor slab or roof above it is used as a return air plenum, so that return air is collected at a central point. Governing codes should be consulted before using this approach in new design, because most codes prohibit combustible material in a ceiling space used as a return air plenum. For example, the *National Electrical Code® Handbook* (NFPA 2017) requires that either conduit or PTFE-insulated wire (often called plenum-rated cable) be installed in a return air plenum. In addition, regulations often require that return air plenums be divided into smaller areas by firewalls and that fire dampers be installed in ducts, which increases first cost.

In research and some industrial facilities, return ducting must be installed to avoid contamination and growth of biological contaminants in the ceiling space. Lobby ceilings with lay-in panels may not work well as return plenums where negative pressure from high-rise elevators or stack effects of high-rise buildings may occur. If the plenum leaks to the low-pressure area, the tiles may lift and drop out when the outer door is opened and closed. Return plenums directly below a roof deck have substantially greater return air temperature increases or decreases than a duct return.

Corridors should not be used for return air because they spread smoke and other contaminants. Although most codes ban returning air through corridors, the method is still used in many older facilities.

All ductwork should be sealed. Energy waste because of leaks in the ductwork and terminal devices can be considerable. Unsealed ductwork in many commercial buildings can have leakage of 20% or more.

Air systems are classified in two categories:

- **Single-duct systems** contain the main heating and cooling coils in a series-flow air path. A common duct distribution system at a common air temperature feeds all terminal apparatus. Capacity can be controlled by varying air temperature or volume.
- **Dual-duct systems** contain the main heating and cooling coils in parallel-flow or series/parallel-flow air paths with either (1) a separate cold- and warm-air duct distribution system that blends air at the terminal apparatus (dual-duct systems), or (2) a separate supply air duct to each zone with the supply air blended at the main unit with mixing dampers (multizone). Dual-duct systems generally vary the supply air temperature by mixing two airstreams of different temperatures, but they can also vary the volume of supply air in some applications.

These categories are further divided and described in the following sections.

2. AIR-HANDLING SYSTEMS

2.1 SINGLE-DUCT SYSTEMS

Constant Volume

While maintaining constant airflow, single-duct constant-volume systems change the supply air temperature in response to the space load (Figure 9).

Single-Zone Systems. The simplest all-air system is a supply unit serving a single zone. The unit can be installed either in or remote from the space it serves, and may operate with or without distribution ductwork. Ideally, this system responds completely to the space needs, and well-designed control systems maintain temperature and humidity closely and efficiently. Single-zone systems often involve short ductwork with low pressure drop and thus low fan energy, and can be shut down when not required without affecting operation of adjacent areas, offering further energy savings. A return or relief fan may be needed, depending on system capacity and whether 100% outdoor air is used for cooling as part of an economizer cycle. Relief fans can be eliminated if overpressurization can be relieved by other means, such as gravity dampers.

Multiple-Zone Reheat Systems. Multiple-zone reheat is a modification of the single-zone system. It provides (1) zone or space control for areas of unequal loading, (2) simultaneous heating or cooling of perimeter areas with different exposures, and (3) close control for process or comfort applications. As the word *reheat* implies, heat is added as a secondary simultaneous process to either preconditioned (cooled, humidified, etc.) primary air or recirculated room air. Relatively small low-pressure systems place reheat coils in the ductwork at each zone. More complex designs include high-pressure primary distribution ducts to reduce their size and cost, and pressure reduction devices to maintain a constant volume for each reheat zone.

The system uses conditioned air from a central unit, generally at a fixed cold-air temperature that is low enough to meet the maximum cooling load. Thus, all supply air is always cooled the maximum amount, regardless of the current load. Heat is added to the airstream in each zone to avoid overcooling that zone, for every zone except the zone experiencing peak cooling demand. The result is very high energy use, so use of this system is restricted by ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1. However, the supply air temperature from the unit can be varied, with proper control, to reduce the amount of reheat required and associated energy consumption. Care must be taken to avoid high internal humidity when the temperature of air leaving the cooling coil is allowed to rise during cooling.

Constant-volume reheat can ensure close control of room humidity and/or space pressure.

In cold weather, when a reheat system heats a space with an exterior exposure, the reheat coil must not only replace the heat lost from the space, but also must offset cooling of the supply air (enough cooling to meet the peak load for the space), further increasing energy consumption. If a constant-volume system is oversized, reheat cost becomes excessive.

In commercial applications, use of a constant-volume reheat system is generally discouraged in favor of variable-volume or other systems. Constant-volume reheat systems may continue to be applied in hospitals, laboratories, and other critical applications where variable airflow may be detrimental to proper pressure relationships (e.g., for infection control).

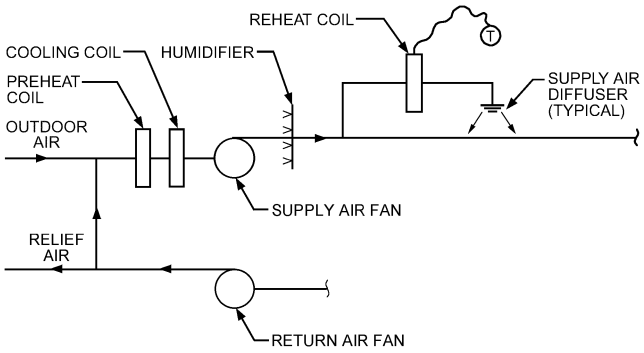

Fig. 9 Constant-Volume System with Reheat

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

Variable Air Volume (VAV)

A VAV system (Figure 10) controls temperature in a space by varying the quantity of supply air rather than varying the supply air temperature. A VAV terminal unit at the zone varies the quantity of supply air to the space. The supply air temperature is held relatively constant. Although supply air temperature can be moderately reset depending on the season, it must always be low enough to meet the cooling load in the most demanding zone and to maintain appropriate relative humidity. VAV systems can be applied to interior or perimeter zones, with common or separate fans, with common or separate air temperature control, and with or without auxiliary heating devices. The greatest energy saving associated with VAV occurs in perimeter zones, where variations in solar load and outdoor temperature allow the supply air quantity to be reduced.

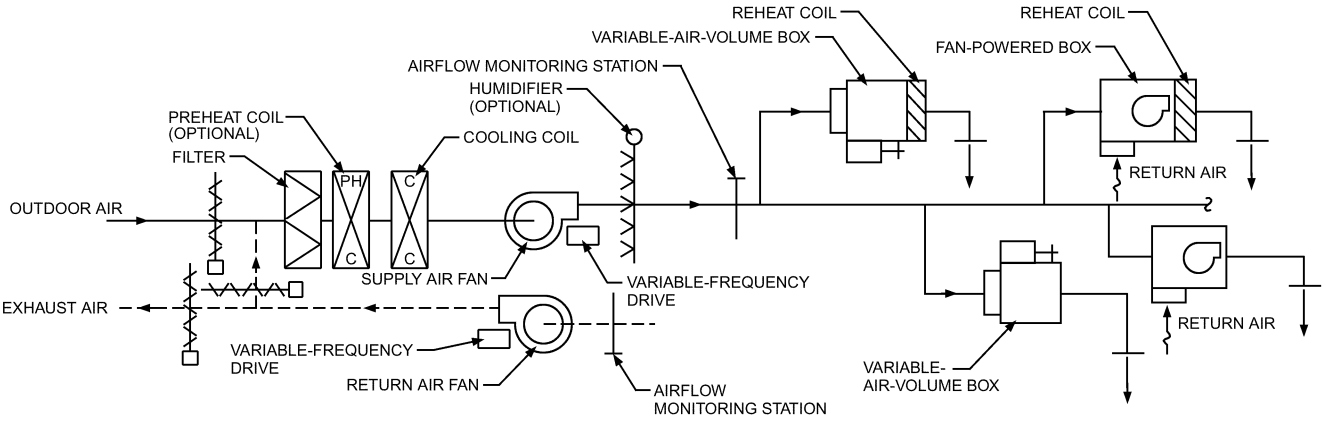

Fig. 10 Variable-Air-Volume System with Reheat and Induction and Fan-Powered Devices

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

Other measures may also maintain enough air circulation through the room to achieve acceptable humidity levels. The human body is more sensitive to elevated air temperatures when there is little air movement. Minimum air circulation can be maintained during reduced load by (1) raising the supply air temperature of the entire system, which increases space humidity, or supplying reheat on a zone-by-zone basis; (2) providing auxiliary heat in each room independent of the air system; (3) using individual-zone recirculation and blending varying amounts of supply and room air or supply and ceiling plenum air with fan-powered VAV terminal units, or, if design allows, at the air-handling unit; (4) recirculating air with a VAV induction unit; or (5) providing a dedicated recirculation fan to increase airflow.

VAV reheat can ensure close room space pressure control with the supply terminal functioning in sync with associated room exhaust. A typical application might be a fume hood VAV exhaust with constant open sash velocity (e.g., 0.4 or 0.5 m/s) or occupied/unoccupied room hood exhaust (e.g., 0.5 m/s at sash in occupied periods and 0.3 m/s in unoccupied periods).

Dual-Conduit. This method is an extension of the single-duct VAV system: one supply duct offsets exterior transmission cooling or heating loads by its terminal unit with or without auxiliary heat, and the other supply air path provides cooling throughout the year. The first airstream (primary air) operates as a constant-volume system, and the air temperature is varied to offset transmission only (i.e., it is warm in winter and cool in summer). Often, however, the primary-air fan is limited to operating only during peak heating and cooling periods to further reduce energy use. When calculating this system's heating requirements, the cooling effect of secondary air must be included, even though the secondary system operates at minimum flow. The other airstream (secondary air) is cool year-round and varies in volume to match the load from solar heating, lights, power, and occupants. It serves both perimeter and interior spaces.

Variable Diffuser. The discharge aperture of this diffuser is reduced to keep discharge velocity relatively constant while reducing conditioned supply airflow. Under these conditions, the diffuser's induction effect is kept high, cold air mixes in the space, and the room air distribution pattern is more nearly maintained at reduced loads. These devices are of two basic types: one has a flexible bladder that expands to reduce the aperture, and the other has a diffuser plate that moves. Both devices are pressure dependent, which must be considered in duct distribution system design. They are either powered by the system or pneumatically or electrically driven.

2.2 DUAL-DUCT SYSTEMS

A dual-duct system conditions all air in a central apparatus and distributes it to conditioned spaces through two ducts, one carrying cold air and the other carrying warm air. In each conditioned zone, air valve terminals mix warm and cold air in proper proportion to satisfy the space temperature and pressure control. Dual-duct systems may be designed as constant volume or variable air volume; a dual-duct, constant-volume system generally uses more energy than a single-duct VAV system. As with other VAV systems, certain primary-air configurations can cause high relative humidity in the space during the cooling season.

Constant Volume

Dual-duct, constant-volume systems using a single supply fan were common through the mid-1980s, and were used frequently as an alternative to constant-volume reheat systems. Today, dual-fan applications are standard. There are two types of dual-duct, single-fan application: with reheat, and without.

Single Fan with Reheat. There are two major differences between this and a conventional terminal reheat system: (1) reheat is applied at a central point in the fan unit hot deck instead of at individual zones (Figure 11), and (2) only part of the supply air is cooled by the cooling coil (except at peak cooling demand); the rest of the supply is heated by the hot-deck coil during most hours of operation. This uses less heating and cooling energy than the terminal reheat system where all the air is cooled to full cooling capacity for more operating hours, and then all of it is reheated as required to match the space load. Fan energy is constant because airflow is constant.

Single Fan without Reheat. This system has no heating coil in the fan unit hot deck and simply pushes a mixture of outdoor and recirculated air through the hot deck. A problem occurs during periods of high outdoor humidity and low internal heat load, causing the space humidity to rise rapidly unless reheat is added. This system has limited use in most modern buildings because most occupants demand more consistent temperature and humidity. A single-fan, no-reheat dual-duct system does not use any extra energy for reheat, but fan energy is constant regardless of space load.

Variable Air Volume

Dual-duct VAV systems blend cold and warm air in various volume combinations. These systems may include single-duct VAV terminal units connected to the cold-air duct distribution system for cooling-only interior spaces (see Figures 11 and 12), and the cold duct may serve perimeter spaces in sync with the hot duct. This saves reheat energy for the air for those cooling-only zones because space temperature control is by varying volume, not supply air temperature, which may save some fan energy to the extent that the airflow matches the load.

Newer dual-duct air terminals provide two damper operators per air terminal, which allows the unit to function like a single-duct VAV cooling terminal unit (e.g., 250 mm inlet damper) and a single-duct VAV heating terminal unit (e.g., 150 mm inlet damper) in one physical terminal package. This arrangement allows the designer to specify the correct cold-air supply damper as part of the dual-duct terminal, which is usually a large supply air quantity in sync with a smaller hot-air supply damper in the same terminal unit. This provides temperature control by means of dual-duct box mixing at minimum airflow; it also saves both heating and cooling energy and fan energy, because the terminal damper sizes are more appropriate for the design flow compared to older dual-duct terminals, which provided same-size cold and hot dampers and a single damper operator that did not allow space temperature and airflow controllability.

Single-Fan, Dual-Duct (SFDD) System. This system (see Figure 11), frequently used as a retrofit to an antiquated dual-duct, single-fan application during the 1980s and 1990s, uses a single supply fan sized for the peak cooling load or the coincident peak of the hot and cold decks. Fan control is from two static-pressure controllers, one located in the hot deck and the other in the cold deck. The duct requiring the highest pressure governs the airflow by signaling the supply fan VFD speed control. An alternative is to add discharge supply air duct damper control to both the cold and hot ducts to vary flow while

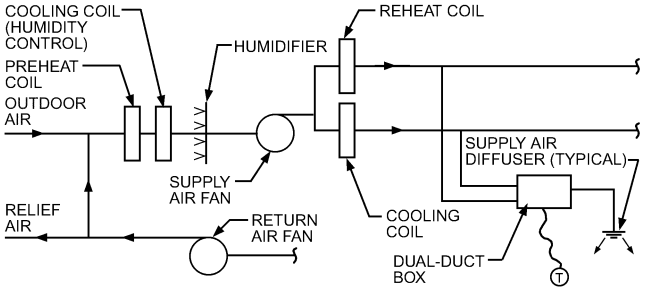

Fig. 11 Single-Fan, Dual-Duct System

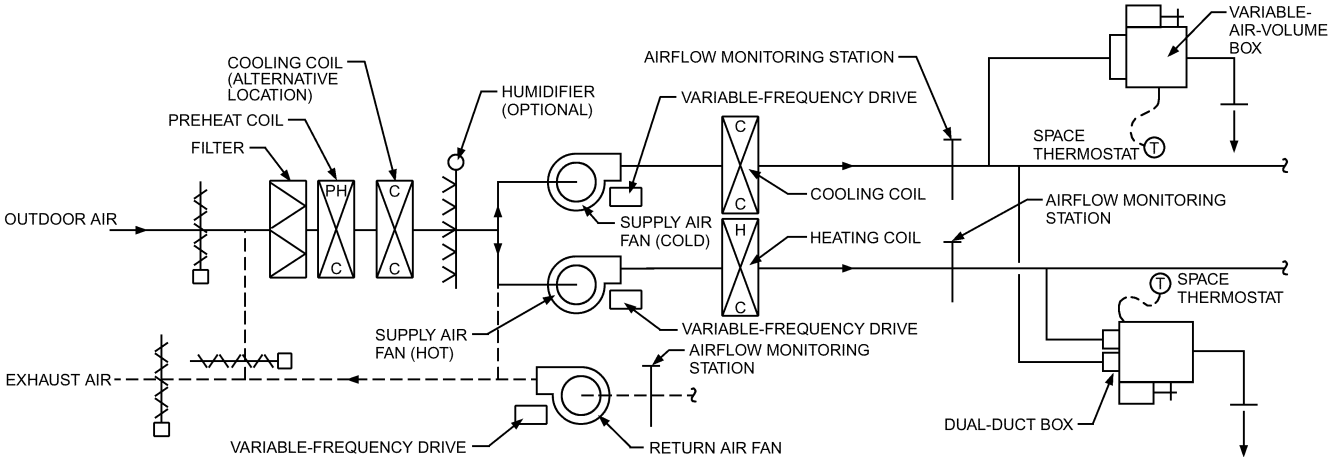

Fig. 12 Dual-Fan, Dual-Duct System

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

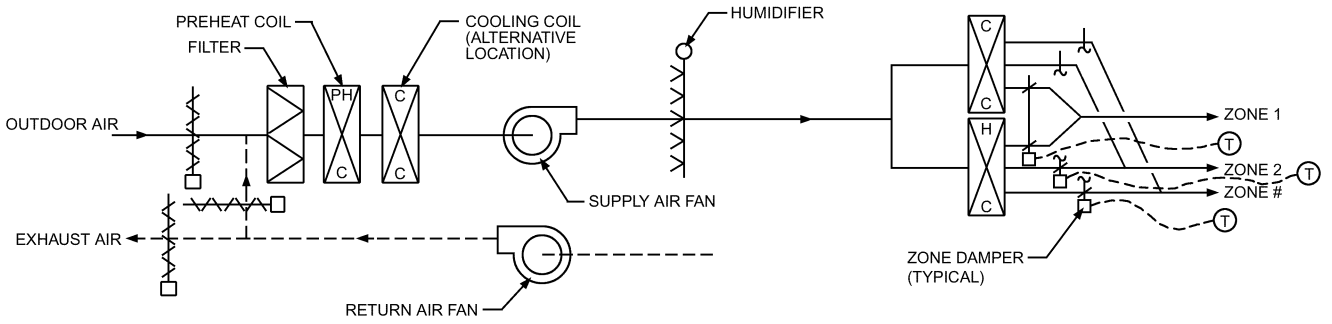

Fig. 13 Multizone System

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

the supply fan operates up and down its fan curve. Return air fan tracking of discharge supply air must be assessed with this application.

Usually, the cold deck is maintained at a fixed temperature, although some central systems allow the temperature to rise during warmer weather to save refrigeration. The hot-deck temperature is often raised during periods of low outdoor temperature and high humidity to increase the flow over the cold deck for dehumidification. Other systems, particularly in laboratories, use a precooling coil to dehumidify the total airstream or just the outdoor air to limit humidity in the space. Return air quantity can be controlled either by flow-measuring devices in the supply and return duct or by static-pressure controls that maintain space static pressure.

Duda (2018b) strongly cautions against applying SFDD in moist climates unless all air is directed across a cooling coil (humidity control; see Figure 11). Otherwise, air traveling down the warm-air branch has no opportunity for dehumidification and some nondehumidified air will be delivered to the space, which can lead to lack of thermal comfort or even conditions hospitable to mold growth. If a zone begins to overcool, the warm-air damper must modulate open to prevent overcooling. If the space is thermally neutral or has only a small net cooling load, supply air can be brought by the warmer duct, which has not been dehumidified. So, loss of indoor relative humidity control will be the result.

Dual-Fan, Dual-Duct (DFDD) System. Supply air volume of each supply fan is controlled independently by the static pressure in its respective duct (Figure 12). The return fan is controlled based on the sum of the hot and cold fan volumes using flow-measuring stations. Each fan is sized for the anticipated maximum coincident hot or cold volume, not the sum of the instantaneous peaks; that is, each fan provides only the amount and temperature of heating or cooling air needed, while maintaining constant airflow in each zone. The cold deck can be maintained at a constant temperature either with mechanical refrigeration, when minimum outdoor air is required, or with an air-side economizer, when outdoor air is below the temperature of the cold-deck set point. This operation does not affect the hot deck, which can recover heat from the return air, and the heating coil need operate only when heating requirements cannot be met using return air. Outdoor air can provide ventilation air via the hot duct when the outdoor air is warmer than the return air. However, controls should be used to prohibit introducing excessive amounts of outdoor air beyond the required minimum when that air is more humid than the return air. This system is highly regarded for critical-care hospitals.

2.3 MULTIZONE SYSTEMS

The multizone system (Figure 13) supplies several zones from a single, centrally located air-handling unit. Different zone requirements are met by mixing cold and warm air through zone dampers at the air-handling unit in response to zone thermostats. The mixed, conditioned air is distributed throughout the building by single-zone ducts. The return air is handled conventionally. The multizone system is similar to the dual-duct system and has the same potential problem with high humidity levels. This system can provide a smaller building with the advantages of a dual-duct system, and it uses packaged equipment, which is less expensive.

Packaged equipment is usually limited to about 12 zones, although built-up systems can include as many zones as can be phys-

ically incorporated in the layout. A multizone system is somewhat more energy efficient than a terminal reheat system because not all the air goes through the cooling coil, which reduces the amount of reheat required. But a multizone system uses essentially the same fan energy as terminal reheat because the airflow is constant.

There are two common variations on the multizone system. A **three-deck multizone** system is similar to the standard multizone system, but bypass zone dampers are installed in the air-handling unit parallel with the hot- and cold-deck dampers. In the **Texas multizone** system, the hot-deck heating coil is removed from the air-handling unit and replaced with an air-resistance plate matching the cooling coil's pressure drop. Individual heating coils are placed in each perimeter zone duct. These heating coils are usually located in the equipment room for ease of maintenance. This system is common in humid climates where the cold deck often produces 9 to 11°C air for humidity control. Using the air-handling units' zone dampers to maintain zone conditions, supply air is then mixed with bypass air rather than heated air. Heat is added only if the zone served cannot be maintained by delivering return air alone. These arrangements can save considerable reheat energy.

2.4 SPECIAL SYSTEMS

Primary/Secondary

Some processes use two interconnected all-air systems (Figure 14). In these situations, space gains are very high and/or a large number of air changes are required (e.g., in sterile or cleanrooms or where close-tolerance conditions are needed for process work). The primary system supplies the conditioned outdoor air requirements for the process to the secondary system. The secondary system provides additional cooling and humidification (and heating, if required) to offset space and fan power gains. Normally, the secondary cooling coil is designed to be dry (i.e., sensible cooling only) to reduce the possibility of bacterial growth, which can create air quality problems. The alternative is to have the primary system supply conditioned outdoor air (e.g., 20 air changes per hour [ach]) to the ceiling return air plenum, where fan-powered HEPA filter units provide the total supply air (e.g., 120 ach) to the occupied space. The total heat gain from the numerous fan-powered motors in the return air plenum must be taken into account.

Dedicated Outdoor Air

Similar in some respects to the primary/secondary system, the dedicated outdoor air system (DOAS) decouples air-conditioning of the outdoor air from conditioning of the internal loads. Long popular in hotels and multifamily residential buildings, DOAS is now gaining popularity in commercial buildings and many other applications. The DOAS introduces 100% outdoor air, heats or cools it, may humidify or dehumidify it, and filters it, then supplies this treated air to each of its assigned spaces. DOAS can accommodate an exhaust or relief airflow for heat recovery between the outdoor and exhaust or relief airflows. Air volume is sized in response to minimum ventilation standards, such as ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1, or to meet makeup air demands. Often, the DOAS serves multiple spaces and is designed not necessarily to control space temperature, but to provide thermally neutral air to those spaces. A second, more conventional system serves those same spaces and is intended to control space temperature. The conventional system is responsible for offsetting building envelope and internal loads. In this instance, however, the conventional system has no responsibility for conditioning or delivering outdoor air. A common example may be a large apartment building with individual fan-coil units (the conventional system) in each dwelling unit, plus a common building-wide DOAS to deliver code-required outdoor air to each housing unit for good indoor air quality and to make up bathroom and/or kitchen exhaust. Another application is to provide minimum outdoor air ventilation while controlling space temperature with radiant panels, chilled beams, valance heating and cooling, etc.

Underfloor Air Distribution

An underfloor air distribution (UFAD) system (Figure 15) uses the open space between a structural floor slab and the underside of a raised-floor system to deliver conditioned air to supply outlets at or near floor level. Floor diffusers make up the large majority of installed UFAD supply outlets, which can provide different levels of individual control over the local thermal environment, depending on diffuser design and location. UFAD systems use variations of the same basic types of equipment at the cooling and heating plants and primary air-handling units as conventional overhead systems do. Variations of UFAD include displacement ventilation and task/ambient systems.

Humidity control is necessary for UFAD air-handling units. In climates requiring dehumidification of outdoor air, a cooling coil leaving temperature of 10 to 13°C is typical. To maintain the higher plenum inlet temperatures of 16 to 18°C airflow required for delivery, mixing return air with outdoor air is necessary. Figure 15 shows a bypass arrangement where the incoming outdoor and a portion of the return air are mixed and dehumidified through the cooling coil, before the remainder of the return air is bypassed around the cooling coil in controlled mixing to maintain the higher plenum supply air temperature.

Displacement ventilation can be a variant of UFAD, using a large number of low-volume supply air outlets to create laminar

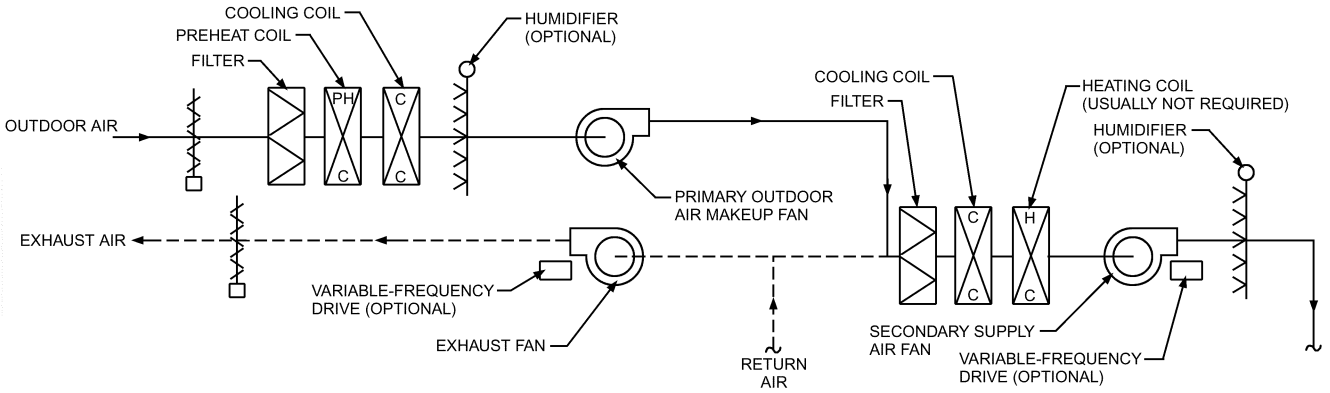

Fig. 14 Primary/Secondary System

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

flow. See Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information.

A **task/ambient conditioning (TAC)** system is defined as any space-conditioning system that allows thermal conditions in small, localized zones (e.g., regularly occupied work locations) to be individually controlled by nearby building occupants while automatically maintaining acceptable environmental conditions in the ambient space of the building (e.g., corridors, open-use space, other areas outdoor of regularly occupied work space). Typically, the occupant can control the perceived temperature of the local environment by adjusting the speed and direction, and in some cases the temperature, of incoming air supply, much like on the dashboard of a car. TAC systems are distinguished from standard UFAD systems by the higher degree of personal comfort control provided by the localized supply outlets. TAC supply outlets use direct-velocity cooling to achieve this level of control, and are therefore most commonly configured as fan-driven (active) jet-type diffusers that are part of the furniture or partitions. Active floor diffusers are also possible.

Unlike conventional HVAC design, in which conditioned air is both supplied and exhausted at ceiling level, UFAD removes supply ducts from the ceilings and allows a smaller overhead ceiling cavity. Less stratification and improved ventilation effectiveness may be achieved with UFAD because air flows from a floor outlet to a ceiling inlet, rather than from a ceiling outlet to a ceiling inlet. UFAD has long been popular in computer room and data center applications, and in Europe in conventional office buildings. Close attention to underfloor tightness is needed because, unlike a supply air duct that is pressure tested for leakage and installed only by the sheet metal contractor, the entire raised-floor structure of the plenum contains elements from multiple trades (e.g., electrical conduits, floor drains, wall partitions) that all influence underfloor structure. Humidity control is needed to prevent condensation on the concrete floor mass. The air also gains and loses heat as the mass of the flooring heats and cools.

For more information, see Chapter 20 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, ASHRAE's *UFAD Guide* (ASHRAE 2016), and Chapters 20 and 32 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Wetted Duct/Supersaturated

Some industries spray water into the airstream at central air-handling units in sufficient quantities to create a controlled carryover (Figure 16). This supercools the supply air, normally equivalent to an oversaturation of about 1.4 g per kilogram of air, and allows less air to be distributed for a given space load. These are used where high humidity is desirable, such as in the textile or tobacco industry, and in climates where adiabatic cooling is sufficient.

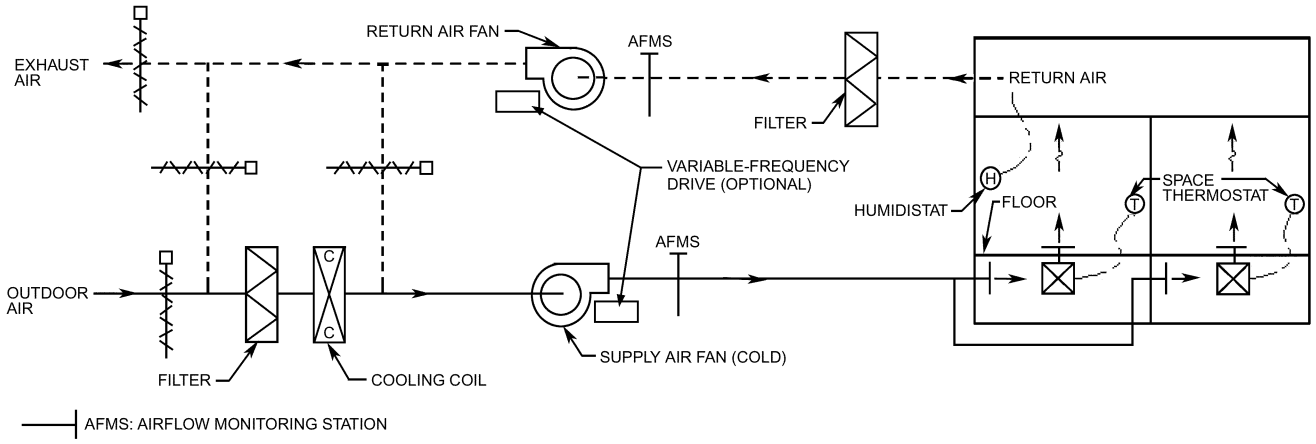

Fig. 15 Underfloor Air Distribution

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

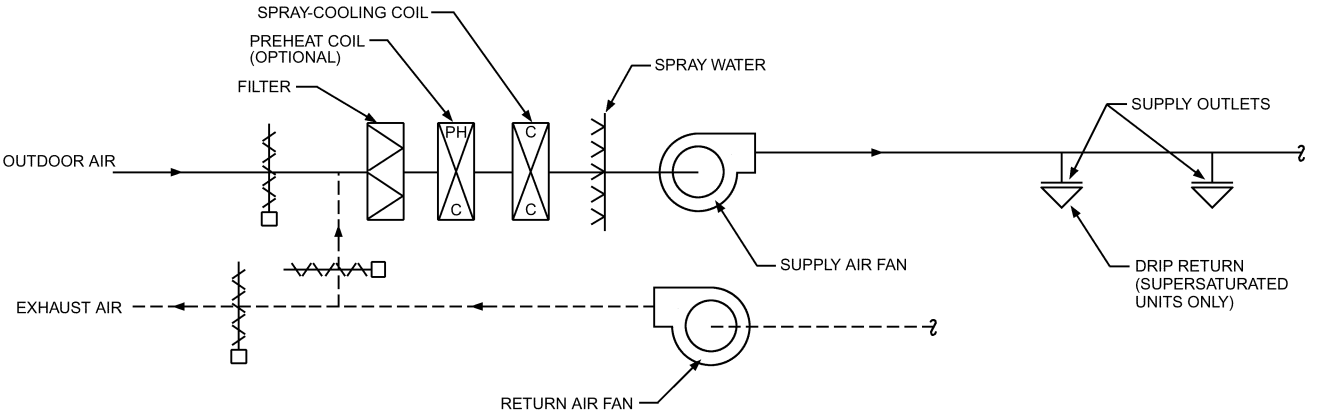

Fig. 16 Supersaturated/Wetted Coil

(Courtesy RDK Engineers)

Compressed-Air and Water Spray

This is similar to the wetted duct system, except that the water is atomized with compressed air and provides limited cooling while maintaining a relatively humid environment. Nozzles are sometimes placed inside the conditioned space and independent of the cooling air supply, and can be used for large, open manufacturing facilities where humidity is needed to avoid static electricity in the space. Several nozzle types are available, and the designer should understand their advantages and disadvantages. Depending on the type of nozzle, compressed-air and water spray systems can require large and expensive air compressors. The extra first cost might be offset by energy cost savings, depending on the application.

Low-Temperature

Ice storage is often used to reduce peak electrical demand. Low-temperature systems (where air is supplied at as low as 5°C) are sometimes used. Benefits include smaller central air-handling units and associated fan power, and smaller supply air duct distribution. At air terminals, fan-powered units are frequently used to increase supply air to the occupied space. Attention to detail is important because of the low air temperature and the potential for excessive condensate on supply air duct distribution in the return plenum space. These fan-powered terminals mix return air or room air with cold supply air to increase the air circulation rate in the space. Alternatively, DFDD systems can be used with low-temperature supply air in one duct.

Smoke Control

Air-conditioning systems are often used for smoke control during fires. Controlled airflow can provide smoke-free areas for occupant evacuation and fire fighter access. Space pressurization creates a low-pressure area at the smoke source, surrounding it with high-pressure spaces. The air-conditioning system can also be designed to provide makeup air for smoke exhaust systems in atria and other large spaces (Duda 2004). For more information, see Chapter 54 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*. Klote et al. (2012) also have detailed information on this topic.

2.5 AIR TERMINAL UNITS

Air terminal units (ATUs) are located between the primary air distribution systems and the conditioned space. There are two main types: (1) passive devices, such as supply outlets (registers or diffusers) and return or exhaust inlets (grilles or registers), and (2) active devices (also known as **boxes**).

Passive devices deliver and extract air throughout the conditioned space without occupants sensing a draft and without creating excessive noise. In systems such as low-velocity all-air systems, airflow amounts and direction entering and leaving the conditioned space are usually manually adjusted; see Chapter 20 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

With **active** devices, the ATU controls the quantity and/or temperature of the supply air to maintain desired conditions in the space. In medium- and high-velocity air systems, ATUs normally control air volume, reduce duct pressure, or both. Various types are available. A VAV terminal varies the amount of air delivered. Air may be delivered to low-pressure ductwork and then to the space, or the air terminal may contain an integral air diffuser. A fan-powered VAV terminal varies the amount of primary air delivered, but it also uses a fan to mix ceiling plenum or return air with primary supply air before it is delivered to the space. An all-air induction terminal controls the volume of primary air, induces a flow of ceiling plenum or space air, and distributes the mixture through low-velocity ductwork to the space. An air/water induction terminal includes a coil or coils in the induced airstream to condition the return air before it mixes with the primary air and enters the space. For more information on ATUs, see Chapter 5.

Constant-Volume Reheat

Constant-volume reheat ATUs are used mainly in terminal reheat systems with medium- to high-velocity ductwork. The unit serves as a pressure-reducing valve and constant-volume regulator to maintain a constant supply air quantity to the space, and is generally fitted with an integral reheat coil that controls space temperature. The constant supply air quantity is selected to provide cooling to match the peak load in the space, and the reheat coil is controlled to raise the supply air temperature as necessary to maintain the desired space temperature at reduced loads.

Variable Air Volume

VAV terminal units are available in many configurations, all of which control the space temperature by varying the volume of cool supply air from the air-handling unit in response to room temperature feedback. VAV terminal units are fitted with automatic controls that are most commonly pressure independent (i.e., they measure actual supply airflow and control flow in response to room temperature). Pressure-independent units may be fitted with a velocity-limit control that overrides the room temperature signal to limit the measured supply velocity to some selected maximum. Velocity-limit control can be used to prevent excess airflow through units nearest the air-handling unit. Excessive airflow at units close to the air-handling unit can draw so much supply air that more distant units do not get enough air.

Throttling without Reheat. Throttling (or pinch-off) without reheat essentially uses an air valve or damper to reduce supply airflow to the space in response to falling space temperature. The unit usually includes some means of sound attenuation to reduce air noise created by the throttling action. It is the simplest and least expensive VAV terminal unit, but is suitable for use only where no heat is required and the zone served is not occupied, allowing the unit to go completely closed at reduced cooling loads. If this type of unit is set up with a minimum position, it will constantly provide cooling to the space, whether the space needs it or not, and can overcool the space. This approach offers the lowest fan energy use, because it minimizes airflow to just the amount required by the cooling load.

Throttling with Reheat. This simple VAV system integrates heating at the terminal unit with the same type of air valve. It is applied in interior and exterior zones where full heating and cooling flexibility is required. These terminal units can be set to maintain a predetermined minimum air quantity necessary to (1) offset the heating load, (2) limit maximum humidity, (3) provide reasonable air movement in the space, and (4) provide required ventilation air. The reheat coil is most commonly hot water or electric resistance.

Variable air volume with reheat allows airflow to be reduced as the first step in control; heat is then initiated as the second step. Compared to constant-volume reheat, this procedure reduces operating cost appreciably because the amount of primary air to be cooled and secondary air to be heated is reduced. Many types of controls can provide control sequences with more than one minimum airflow. This type of dual-maximum control allows the ATU to go to a lower flow rate that just meets ventilation requirements at the lightest cooling loads, then increase to a higher flow rate when the heating coil is energized (Taylor et al. 2012). A feature can be provided to isolate the availability of reheat during the summer, except in situations where even low airflow would overcool the space and should be avoided or where increased humidity causes discomfort (e.g., in conference rooms when the lights are turned off).

Because the reheat coil requires some minimum airflow to deliver heat to the space, and because the reheat coil must absorb all of the cooling capacity of that minimum airflow before it starts to

deliver heat to the space, energy use can be significantly higher than with throttling ATUs that go fully closed.

Dual-Duct. Dual-duct systems typically feature throttling dual-duct VAV air terminal units. These terminal units are very similar to the single-duct VAV ATUs except that two primary air inlets are provided. This allows connection of one primary air inlet to a heating duct and the other to a cooling duct. The dual-duct ATU then modulates both air dampers in response to instructions from a thermostat. Dual-duct ATUs are generally available in a constant-volume output, with cooling and heating dampers operating in tandem but inversely such that the sum total of heating plus cooling is always relatively constant. Dual-duct ATUs are also available in a variable-volume output, with only the cooling or heating damper allowed to stroke open at any given time, such that cooling damper must be closed before the heating damper can stroke open. Minimum positions are available on these dampers to meet minimum ventilation airflow requirements even when little or no airflow would otherwise be required.

Induction. The VAV induction system uses an ATU to reduce cooling capacity by simultaneously reducing primary air and inducing room or ceiling air (replacing the reheat coil) to maintain a relatively constant room supply volume. This operation is the reverse of the bypass air terminal. The primary-air quantity decreases with load, retaining the savings of VAV, and the air supplied to the space is kept relatively constant to avoid the effect of stagnant air or low air movement. VAV induction units require a higher inlet static pressure, which requires more fan energy, to achieve the velocities necessary for induction. Today, induction units have for the most part been displaced by fan-powered ATUs, which allow reduction of inlet static pressure and, in turn, reduced central air-handling unit fan power.

Fan-Powered. Fan-powered systems are available in either parallel or series airflow. In **parallel-flow** units, the fan is located outside the primary airstream to allow intermittent fan operation. A backdraft damper on the terminal fan prevents conditioned air from escaping into the return air plenum when the terminal fan is off. In **series** units, the fan is located in the primary airstream and runs continuously when the zone is occupied. These constant-airflow fan ATUs in a common return plenum can help maintain indoor air quality by recirculating air from overventilated zones to zones with greater outdoor air ventilation requirements.

Fan-powered systems, both series and parallel, are often selected because they maintain higher air circulation through a room at low loads but still retain the advantages of VAV systems. As the cold primary-air valve modulates from maximum to minimum (or closed), the unit recirculates more plenum air. In a perimeter zone, a hot-water heating coil, electric heater, baseboard heater, or remote radiant heater can be sequenced with the primary-air valve to offset external heat losses. Between heating and cooling operations, the fan only recirculates ceiling air. This allows heat from lights to be used for space heating, for maximum energy saving. During unoccupied periods, the main supply air-handling unit remains off and individual fan-powered heating zone terminals are cycled to maintain required space temperature, thereby reducing operating cost during unoccupied hours.

Fans for fan-powered air-handling units operated in series are sized and operated to maintain minimum static pressures at the unit inlet connections. This reduces fan energy for the central air-handling unit, but the small fans in fan-powered units are less efficient than the large air-handling unit fans. As a result, the series fan-powered unit (where small fans operate continuously) may use more fan energy than a throttling unit system. However, the extra fan energy may be more than offset by the reduction in reheat through the recovery of plenum heat and the ability to operate a small fan to deliver heat during unoccupied hours where heat is needed.

Because fan-powered ATUs involve an operating fan, they may generate higher sound levels than throttling ATUs. Acoustical ceilings generally are not very effective sound barriers, so extra care should be taken in considering the sound level in critical spaces near fan-powered terminal units.

Both parallel and series fan-powered terminal units should be provided with filters. A disadvantage of this type of terminal unit is the need to periodically change these filters, making them unsuitable for installation above inaccessible ceilings. A large building could contain hundreds of fan-powered terminal units, some of which might be located in inconvenient locations above office furniture or executive offices. Select installation locations carefully for maximum accessibility.

The constant (series) fan VAV terminal can accommodate minimum (down to zero) flow at the primary-air inlet while maintaining constant airflow to the space.

Both types of fan-powered units and induction terminal units are usually located in the ceiling plenum to recover heat from lights. This sometimes allows these terminals to be used without reheat coils in internal spaces. Perimeter-zone units are sometimes located above the ceiling of an interior zone where heat from lights maintains a higher plenum temperature. Provisions must still be made for morning warm-up and night heating. Also, interior spaces with a roof load must have heat supplied either separately in the ceiling or at the terminal.

Terminal Humidifiers

Most projects requiring humidification use steam. This can be centrally generated as part of the heating plant, where potential contamination from water treatment of the steam is more easily handled and therefore of less concern. Where there is a concern, local generators (e.g., electric or gas) that use treated water are used. Compressed-air and water humidifiers are used to some extent, and supersaturated systems are used exclusively for special circumstances, such as industrial processes. Spray-type washers and wetted coils are also more common in industrial facilities. When using water directly, particularly in recirculating systems, the water must be treated to avoid dust accumulation during evaporation and the build-up of bacterial contamination.

Terminal Filters

In addition to air-handling unit filters, terminal filters may be used at the supply outlets to protect particular conditioned spaces where an extra-clean environment is desired (e.g., in a hospital's surgery suite). Chapter 29 discusses this topic in detail.

2.6 AIR DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM CONTROLS

Controls should be automatic and simple for best operating and maintenance efficiency. Operations should follow a natural sequence. Depending on the space need, one controlling thermostat closes a normally open heating valve, opens the outdoor air mixing dampers, or opens the cooling valve. In certain applications, an enthalpy controller, which compares the heat content of outdoor air to that of return air, may override the temperature controller. This control opens the outdoor air damper when conditions reduce the refrigeration load. On smaller systems, a dry-bulb control saves the cost of enthalpy control and approaches these savings when an optimum changeover temperature, above the design dew point, is established. Controls are discussed in more detail in Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* and in ASHRAE *Guideline* 36.

Air-handling systems, especially variable-air-volume systems, should include means to measure and control the amount of outdoor air being brought in to ensure adequate ventilation for acceptable indoor air quality. Strategies include the following:

- Separate constant-volume 100% outdoor air ventilation systems
- Outdoor air injection fan
- Directly measuring the outdoor air flow rate
- Modulating the return damper to maintain a constant pressure drop across a fixed outdoor air orifice
- Airflow-measuring systems that measure both supply and return air volumes and maintain a constant difference between them.
- CO_2- and/or VOC-based demand-controlled ventilation

A minimum outdoor air damper with separate motor, selected for a velocity of 7.5 m/s, is preferred to one large outdoor air damper with minimum stops. A separate damper simplifies air balancing. Proper selection of outdoor, relief, and return air dampers is critical for efficient operation. Most dampers are grossly oversized and are, in effect, unable to control. One way to solve this problem is to provide maximum and minimum dampers. A high velocity across a wide-open damper is essential to its providing effective control.

A mixed-air temperature control can reduce operating costs and also reduce temperature swings from load variations in the conditioned space. Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* shows control diagrams for various arrangements of central system equipment. Direct digital control (DDC) is common, and most manufacturers offer either a standard or optional DDC package for equipment, including air-handling units, terminal units, etc. These controls offer considerable flexibility. DDC controls offer the additional advantage of the ability to record actual energy consumption or other operating parameters of various components of the system, which can be useful for optimizing control strategies.

Constant-Volume Reheat. This system typically uses two subsystems for control: one controls the discharge air conditions from the air-handling unit, and the other maintains the space conditions by controlling the reheat coil.

Variable Air Volume. Air volume can be controlled by duct-mounted terminal units serving multiple air outlets in a control zone or by units integral to each supply air outlet.

Pressure-independent volume-regulator units control flow in response to the thermostat's call for heating or cooling. The required flow is maintained regardless of fluctuation of the VAV unit inlet or system pressure. These units can be field- or factory-adjusted for maximum and minimum (or shutoff) air settings. They operate at inlet static pressures as low as 50 Pa.

The type of controls available for VAV units varies with the terminal device. Most use electronic controls. Components for both control and regulation are usually contained in the terminal device. As individual-zone VAV terminals begin to modulate closed, static pressure in the supply air duct increases. To save energy, the AHU's supply air fan speed should be reset based on VAV box damper position (i.e., the duct static pressure set point is reset lower until one zone damper is nearly wide open). The preferred strategy is **trim and respond** (Taylor 2015), in which pressure set point is reset slowly and regularly until a zone requests that more pressure is required, in which case the controller bumps the set point up a small amount.

Dual Duct. Because dual-duct systems are generally more costly to install than single-duct systems, their use is less widespread. DDC, with its ability to maintain set points and flow accurately, can make dual-duct systems worthwhile for certain applications. They should be seriously considered as alternatives to single-duct systems.

Personnel. The skill levels of personnel operating and maintaining the air conditioning and controls should be considered. In large research and development or industrial complexes, experienced personnel are available for maintenance. On small and sometimes even large commercial installations, however, office managers are often responsible, so designs must be in accordance with their capabilities.

Water System Interface. On large hydronic installations where direct blending is used to maintain (or reset) the secondary-water temperature, the system valves and coils must be accurately sized for proper control. Many designers use variable flow for hydronic as well as air systems, so the design must be compatible with the air system to avoid operating problems.

Relief Fans. In many applications, relief or exhaust fans can be started in response to a signal from the economizer control or to a space pressure controller. The main supply fan must be able to handle the return air pressure drop when the relief fan is not running.

2.7 AUTOMATIC CONTROLS AND BUILDING MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS

Central air-handling units increasingly come with prepackaged and prewired automatic control systems. Controls may also be accessible by the building manager using a modem to an off-site computer. Larger building HVAC systems integrate manufacturers' control packages with the building management system (BMS). If the project is an addition or major renovation of space, prepackaged controls and their capabilities need to be compatible with existing automatic controls. Chapter 41 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* discusses computer applications, and ASHRAE *Standard* 135 discusses interfacing building automation systems.

Automatic temperature controls can be important in establishing a simple or complex control system, more so with all-air systems than with air-and-water and all-water systems. Maintaining these controls can be challenging to building management staff. With a focus on energy management and indoor air quality, the building management system can be an important business tool in achieving sustainable facility management success.

Rather than having every consulting engineer write custom control sequences of operation for numerous similar air-handling unit systems, those engineers are now encouraged to specify already-vetted controls diagrams, control points lists, and sequences of operation found in ASHRAE *Guideline* 36. This guideline was created to publish and maintain optimized sequences for VAV air handlers and VAV terminal units, including the trim and respond sequence. Controls manufacturers are expected to preprogram those sequences into their controllers and simply use the programming directly, with only minimal project-specific configuration needed.

2.8 MAINTENANCE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

Maintenance management for central air-handling units involves many component and devices, with a varied lists of tasks (e.g., check belts, lube fittings, replace filters, adjust dampers), and varied times and frequencies, depending on components and devices (e.g., check damper linkage monthly, change filters based on pressure drop). Small installations may be best served by local service contractors, in lieu of in-house personnel; larger installations may be best served with in-house technicians. See Chapter 40 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for further discussion.

AHU location affects maintenance. Units located outdoors, especially in climates with long, cold winters, may discourage or impede routine or preventative maintenance. Unfavorable weather can impair important unplanned repairs, such as a broken fan belt during a snow storm. For units located on a building roof, acceptable and safe access must be provided. Roof-mounted units must be located at least 3 m away from the roof edge. Alternatively, if the air-handling equipment must be located closer to the roof edge, a 1 m high parapet or guard rail (designed not to pass a 533 mm sphere) must be provided and needs to extend at least 762 mm beyond each end of the equipment.

Air-handling units located indoors require adequate access and clearance for maintenance as well. Model codes require that any room containing equipment be provided with an unobstructed passageway from the door to the equipment, measuring no less than

914 mm wide and 2 m high, and a level working space at least 762 by 762 mm must be provided in front of the control side for servicing. Engineers and designers should insist on adequate mechanical room service space and annotate the service aisles clearly in their designs. In addition to the obvious need for maintenance access, a clear, unobstructed path of egress out of the room is necessary in the event of fire or other emergency.

2.9 BUILDING SYSTEM COMMISSIONING

Prepackaged control systems use a different automatic control checkout process than traditional control contractors. When commissioning a building system that integrates an independent (non-*Guideline* 36) control system with individual packaged control systems, the process can be more cumbersome because both control contractors need to participate. Air and water balancing for each all-air system are also important. With the complexity of air systems and numerous modes of operation (e.g., economizer cycle, minimum outdoor air, smoke control mode), it is essential to adjust and balance systems before system commissioning.

Ongoing commissioning or recommissioning should be integral to maintaining each central air system. ASHRAE *Guideline* 0 and *Standard* 202 should be applied. During the warranty phase, all-air system performance should be measured and benchmarked to ensure continuous system success. Retro- or recommissioning should be considered whenever the facility is expanded or an additional connection made to the existing systems, to ensure the original design intent is met.

When completing TAB and commissioning, consider posting laminated system flow diagrams at or adjacent to the air-handling unit, indicating operating instructions, TAB performance, commissioning functional performance tests, and emergency shutoff procedures. These documents also should be filed electronically in the building manager's computer server for quick reference.

Original basis of design and design criteria should be posted as a constant reminder of design intent, and be readily available in case troubleshooting, expansion, or modernization is needed.

For the HVAC design to succeed, commissioning should include the system training requirements necessary for building management staff to efficiently take ownership and operate and maintain the HVAC systems over the service life of the installation.

Commissioning continues until the final commissioning report, approximately one year after the construction phase has been completed and the warranty phase comes to an end.

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CHAPTER 5

IN-ROOM TERMINAL SYSTEMS

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VERY early in the design process, the HVAC design engineer must analyze and ultimately select appropriate systems, as discussed in Chapter 1. Next, production of heating and cooling is selected as decentralized (see Chapter 2) or centralized (see Chapter 3). Finally, distribution of heating and cooling to the end-use space can be done by an all-air system (see Chapter 4), or a variety of all-water or air/water systems and local terminals, as discussed in this chapter.

One option is using in-room terminal systems to provide heating and/or cooling to individual zones. Terminal units include consoles, fan-coils, blower coils, unit ventilators, chilled beams, and radiant panels. Terminal systems add heat energy or absorb the heat in the conditioned space served. The medium that transfers the heat either from the space to the outdoors or from a heat source to the conditioned spaces may be the same as used with nonterminal systems. Typical uses of in-room terminal unit systems include hotels/motels, apartments and multifamily dwellings, classrooms, and health care facilities. In older office buildings, in-room terminal units were commonly used for perimeter rooms, combined with central air handlers that served the interior spaces. Systems of this type are making a comeback with the introduction of variable-refrigerant-flow (VRF) equipment, combined with dedicated outdoor air systems (DOAS). Historical preservation projects often use in-room terminal units to minimize the space problems due to running ductwork in historical structures.

1. SYSTEM CHARACTERISTICS

Terminal-unit systems can be designed to provide complete sensible and latent cooling and heating to an end-use space; however, most terminal systems are best used with a central ventilation system providing pretreated air to the space. Heat can be provided by hot water, steam, direct expansion (DX), or an electric heating coil. Cooling can be provided by chilled-water or DX coils. Heat pumps (discussed in Chapter 2) can be used, either with a piped water loop (water-source) or air cooled. In-room terminals usually condition a single space, but some (e.g., a large fan-coil unit) may serve several spaces. In-room terminal systems can allow individual space control of heating or cooling during intermediate seasons; satisfying the heating and cooling needs of various rooms on a single system. A thermostat for each terminal unit provides individual zone temperature control.

A terminal unit used **with central ventilation** provides the cooling or heating necessary to handle only the sensible heat gain or loss caused by the building envelope and occupancy. Ventilation (primary) air is delivered by a separate ducted system, either to the terminal unit or ducted directly to the space, and should be pretreated to handle the total latent load of the ventilation air, occupancy, and the space, as well as the sensible load of the ventilation air.

Terminal units **without central ventilation** require additional coil capacity to heat or cool and dehumidify the ventilation air required for the end space. Terminal units are commonly small, with minimal coil rows; therefore, providing this additional capacity is often difficult. Care must be taken to minimize the risk of frozen coils in the winter, and to have enough cooling capacity to not only cool, but also dehumidify ventilation air in the summer. Terminal units have very small fans, so ventilation air must be provided to the unit from a central fan-powered source or supplied from a nearby opening in the building skin, thereby limiting the location of terminal units to the exterior wall of the building. Individual outdoor air fans with filters are also an option.

Although a single in-room terminal unit can be applied to a single room of a large building, this chapter covers applying multiple in-room terminal units to form a complete air-conditioning system for a building.

Advantages

Advantages of all in-room terminal unit systems include the following:

- The delivery system for the space heating and cooling needs (piping versus duct systems) requires less building space (a smaller central fan room, or none, and little duct space)
- System has all the benefits of a central cooling and heating plant, but allows local terminals to be shut off in unused areas
- Individual room temperature control allows each thermostat to be adjusted for a different temperature
- Minimal cross contamination of recirculated air
- Because this system can heat with low-temperature water, it is particularly suitable for use with solar or low-temperature/high-efficiency boilers or with heat recovery equipment
- Failure of a single in-room unit affects only the one room or area, allowing other spaces to continue to operate
- Facilities personnel can remove and replace an in-room terminal unit in hours, allowing them to install a spare and have the room back in service quickly; units are comparatively inexpensive, small, and light, so the owner has the option of stocking spare units on the premises
- Maintenance procedures generally can be done by nonlicensed HVAC personnel, allowing in-house crews to complete the tasks
- Controls for each unit are very simple
- Central control systems can be incorporated to control unit operation and space temperatures during unoccupied hours

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 9.1, Large Building Air-Conditioning Systems.

In-room terminal unit systems with central ventilation air have these additional advantages:

- The central air-handling apparatus used for central ventilation air is smaller than that of an all-air system because less air must be conditioned at that location.
- Space can be heated without operating the primary air system, using just the in-room terminal units. Nighttime primary fan operation is avoided in an unoccupied building. Emergency power for heating, if required, is much lower than for most all-air systems.
- Dehumidification, filtration, and humidification of ventilation air are performed in a central location remote from conditioned spaces.
- They allow using central heat recovery devices such as heat wheels.
- Ventilation air is positively supplied and can accommodate constant recommended outdoor air quantities, regardless of the temperature control of the room.
- Use of central ventilation air with terminal units in some climates can prevent the negative pressurization problems that occur when occupants turn off in-room units.

Disadvantages

- For many buildings, in-room terminals are limited to perimeter space; separate systems are required for other areas.
- In-room terminal unit fans with very little, if any, ductwork can be noisy. Many manufacturers have addressed this and provided units that are acceptable in many situations.
- Because of the individual space control, more controls are needed than for many all-air systems.
- The system is not appropriate for spaces with high exhaust requirements (e.g., research laboratories) unless supplementary ventilation air is provided.
- Central dehumidification eliminates condensation on the secondary-water heat transfer surface (see the section on Secondary-Water Distribution) under maximum design latent load, but abnormal moisture sources (e.g., open windows, cooking, people congregating, a failed primary-air system) can cause annoying or damaging condensation. Therefore, a condensate pan must be provided as for other systems.
- Primary-air supply usually is constant with no provision for shutoff. This is a disadvantage in residential applications, where tenants or hotel room guests may prefer to turn off the air conditioning, or where management may desire to do so to reduce operating expense; however, this can help to stabilize pressurization of a building when exhaust fans are centrally controlled or in constant operation.
- Low chilled-water temperature and/or deep chilled-water coils are needed at the central ventilation air unit to control space humidity adequately. Low chilled-water temperatures can result in excessive condensation occurring at terminal units, if chilled-water valves are not used to shut off water flow through the terminal unit when the terminal unit fan is off.
- Low primary-air temperatures can require heavily insulated ducts; however, using neutral air temperatures minimizes this requirement and prevents overcooling of some spaces.
- In-room terminal units without central ventilation air may result in greater infiltration levels due to numerous penetrations of the exterior of the building, which must be sealed adequately to prevent air infiltration and water intrusion. This may be accentuated in winter conditions, when wind pressures and stack effects become more significant.
- Adding necessary humidity in the winter is difficult.
- Maintenance must be done within the occupied space, which may disrupt space use.

Heating and Cooling Calculations

Basic calculations for airflow, temperatures, relative humidity, loads, and psychrometrics are covered in Chapters 1, 17, and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Use caution in determining peak load conditions for each space served by a terminal unit. Rather than depending on guidelines for typical lighting, ventilation, infiltration, equipment, and occupancy levels, the designer should try to get realistic values based on the particular owner's use plans for the facility. If the client has an existing or similar facility, visiting it to understand the actual occupancy hours, concentration of equipment, and occupancy should help avoid unrealistic assumptions. Incorporating effects of planned energy-saving features (e.g., daylighting; high-efficiency/low-heat-producing lighting; shading apparatus for privacy, glare, or solar radiant control; fan and outdoor air modulation; full-building energy management control strategies) can prevent oversizing of terminal units and resulting potential loss of humidity control. Determining areas where the normal base load will be a small percentage of the concentrated usage load and understanding the usage schedule for the area can allow equipment selection and control strategies to maximize energy savings and still provide excellent comfort control in both extremes. Energy standards may result in calculations that differ from actual use.

For example, in a zone with a terminal unit sized for 2 kW (common for offices), a simple change of four 100 W incandescent light bulbs to compact fluorescents could reduce the space's heat load by about 18% of the unit's capacity, or even more with LED. If this is the consistent peak load of the space for future years, the terminal unit is oversized. Unless a central ventilation pretreatment system handles the entire latent load of the space and the outdoor air, humidity control will be lost in the space. In many climate zones, this may not be significant.

Integrated building design (IBD) techniques should be used to ensure the building envelope provides adequate energy efficiency, airtightness, and moisture penetration control to allow terminal units to control the indoor environmental conditions without need for excessive moisture control in each space. Close cooperation of all parties during design is necessary to create an overall building design that minimizes the required mechanical systems' energy consumption while achieving good indoor conditions. For details on IBD, see Chapter 60 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Computer programs generally can model primary ventilation systems as well as secondary in-room terminal systems. Most, however, do not allow the user to assign the room latent load as part of the primary ventilation system capacity requirement. Therefore, the designer needs to either manually determine final capacity requirements for both the primary and in-room units, or use overrides and manual inputs to redistribute the loads within the computer program after initial sensible and latent loads as well as block and peak conditions have been determined.

The design refrigeration load is determined by considering the entire portion or block of the building served by the air-and-water or DX system at the same time. Because the load on the secondary-water system depends on the simultaneous demand of all spaces, the sum of the individual room or zone peaks is not considered, unless individual DX systems are used.

Space Heating

Some in-room terminal units provide only heating to the end space. Equipment such as cabinet or unit heaters, radiant panels, radiant floors, and finned-tube radiators are designed for heating only. Extreme care must be used with these systems if they are incorporated into a two-pipe changeover piping distribution system, or any other system in which secondary water being piped is not

consistently over 38°C. The heating coils in these units are not designed to handle condensation, and there is no drain pipe in the unit. If cold water is provided to these units, dripping condensation from units, valves, or piping may damage building finishes or saturate the insulation, leading to mold growth. Ball valves tied into the automatic temperature control (ATC) system and/or aquastats should be provided to prevent water at temperatures below space air dew point from reaching heating-only terminal units.

Central (Primary-Air) Ventilation Systems

Generally, the supply air volume from the central apparatus is constant and is called primary or ventilation air to distinguish it from recirculated room air or secondary air. The quantity of primary air supplied to each space is determined by the amount of outdoor air required by codes and other applicable guidelines for ventilation. If in-room terminal units are heating-only units, then the primary-air system must also provide the required sensible cooling capacity at maximum room cooling load, unless cooling is not required. The air may be from outdoors, or may be mixed outdoor and return air. During the cooling season, air is dehumidified sufficiently in the central conditioning unit to maintain required humidity conditions and to prevent condensation on the in-room terminal unit cooling coil. (Both outdoor air and space latent loads should be handled by the central unit.) Centrally supplied air can be supplied at a low enough dew point to absorb moisture generated in the space, but as a minimum should be supplied at a condition such that the room terminal unit has to remove only the space-generated latent load (this is only appropriate with unit ventilators with the capability to handle the latent space loads). In winter, moisture can be added centrally to limit dryness.

As the primary air is dehumidified, it is also cooled. The air should be cool enough when delivered to offset part of the room sensible loads without overcooling the spaces. If the necessary amount of cooling (i.e., that needed to dehumidify primary air to handle all of the space and outdoor air latent loads) is likely to overcool the end spaces, the primary air should be adjusted to avoid overcooling. A heating coil may be required as a preheater in areas with freezing weather. Alternatively, heating can occur at the terminal units, where only a minimal number of spaces might be overcooled due to outdoor air conditions.

When outdoor air is introduced from a central ventilation system, it may be connected to the inlet plenum of some in-room terminal units (fan-coils, unit ventilators, active chilled beams, or induction units), or introduced directly into the space. If introduced directly, ensure that this air is pretreated, dehumidified, and held at a temperature approximately equal to room temperature so as not to cause occupant discomfort when the space unit is off. Caution should always be used to prevent overcooling or loss of humidity control from ventilation air, which can lead to condensation problems on surfaces as well as discomfort for occupants.

In the ideal in-room terminal unit design, the cooling coil is always dry, greatly extending terminal unit life and eliminating odors and the possibility of bacterial growth in the unit in the occupied space, as well as limiting condensation issues in the spaces. In this case, in-room terminals may be replaced by radiant panels (see Chapter 6) or chilled beams and panels, as the primary air controls the space humidity. Therefore, the moisture content of primary air must be low enough to offset the room's latent heat gain and to maintain a room dew point low enough to preclude condensation on the secondary cooling surface.

Even though some systems operate successfully with little or no condensate, a condensate drain is recommended. In systems that shut down during off hours, start-up load may include a considerable dehumidification load, producing moisture to be drained away. In climates with elevated outdoor air dew points during space-cooling periods, piped condensate removal systems that can be maintained regularly should always be included.

Central Plant Sizing

Central equipment size is based on the block load of the entire building at the time of the building peak load, not on the sum of individual in-room terminal unit peak loads. Cooling load should include appropriate diversity factors for lighting and occupant loads. Heating load is based on maintaining the unoccupied building (where there is not continuous occupancy) at design temperature, plus an additional allowance for pickup capacity if the building temperature is set back at night. For additional information, see Chapter 3.

If water supply temperatures or quantities are to be reset at times other than at peak load, the adjusted settings must be adequate for the most heavily loaded space in the building. Analysis of individual room load variations is required.

If the side of the building exposed to the sun or interior zone loads requires chilled water in cold weather, consider using condenser water with a water-to-water heat exchanger, a four-pipe system, or other water economizer methods. Varying refrigeration loads require the water chiller to operate satisfactorily under all conditions, but verify accordance with local energy laws for allowable operation.

Building Pressurization

As with any HVAC system, the amount of ventilation air required depends on the number of occupants in the space as well as other factors (see ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1). The rate of airflow per person or per unit area is also usually dictated by state codes, based on activity in the space and contaminant loads. If the amount of ventilation air required is considerable (i.e., 10% or more of a space's total supply air volume), the designer needs to consider how the excess air will move out of the space and the building. Means of preventing overpressurization may have to be provided, depending on building tightness, amount of exhaust, and other considerations. Additionally, the designer should consider heat recovery for the rejected air.

First, Operating, and Maintenance Costs

As with all systems, the initial cost of an in-room terminal system varies widely, depending on location, local economy, and contractor preference (even for identical systems). For example, a through-wall unit ventilator system is less expensive than fan-coil units with a central ventilation system, because it does not require extensive ductwork distribution. The operating cost depends on the system selected, the designer's skill in selecting and correctly sizing components, and efficiency of the duct and piping systems. A terminal unit design without a central ventilation system is often one of the less expensive systems to install, but in most situations will not operate without some condensation and humidity issues.

Because in-room terminal equipment is in each occupied space, maintenance may be more time consuming, depending on the size and use of the facility. The equipment and components are less complex than other equipment. A common method of repairing in-room terminal units is to simply disconnect and replace a nonfunctioning unit, minimizing the time spent in the occupied space. The nonfunctioning unit can then be repaired in a workshop and used as a spare. The number of individual units is much greater than in many systems, therefore increasing the number of control valves. If a building automation system (BAS) is used, the number of control points is increased as well, which raises the first cost and maintenance costs of the controls.

Energy

The engineer's early involvement in design of any facility can considerably reduce the building's energy consumption; collaboration between the architect and engineer allows optimization of

energy conservation measures, including the building envelope, as well as selection of an HVAC system that is energy efficient with minimal operational costs. In practice, however, a system might be selected based on low first cost or to perform a particular task. In general, terminal units can save energy if the BAS controls operation of the units and can deenergize them if the space is unoccupied. This adds significant cost to the control system, but can save on operational costs. If a central ventilation system is used, energy recovery in the air handler should be considered to minimize operation costs.

The choice of two- or four-pipe piping system and the design of the piping system is another energy-impacting decision. Pumping power, insulation to control heat losses, and the number of yearly changeovers all affect the appropriateness and available energy savings of each type of piping system.

Life-Cycle Costs

Life-cycle costs include the first, operational, maintenance, and replacement costs over a predetermined length of time. With an in-room terminal system, a major portion of the cost of the system is the insulated piping infrastructure needed to provide the primary and secondary equipment with water (or refrigerant). When properly selected, installed, and maintained, these components have a very long expected life. The in-room terminal units are generally of simple design and complexity and can be readily repaired. As a general rule, the less condensate that occurs at the in-room units, the longer their life span. Selection of good-quality central ventilation equipment can result in quite lengthy life spans for these units. Operational concerns that affect costs are discussed throughout this chapter. Consult Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information on equipment life expectancies and predicting maintenance costs.

2. SYSTEM COMPONENTS AND CONFIGURATIONS

Components

Terminal units have common components; mainly, a fan, coil(s), filter, dampers, and controls (although some units only have coils and controls).

Damper. If a terminal unit is providing ventilation air through the envelope of the building, a damper is needed to stop airflow when the room is at unoccupied status. Because in-room terminal units often have a ducted primary- or central ventilation air system, a damper on the primary system duct allows airflow to be balanced. Many less expensive in-room terminal units have manual dampers rather than automatic. Regardless of whether dampers are manually operated or automatic, pressurization problems can occur because of damper position compared with exhaust fan operation and primary air system operation, so the designer needs to carefully coordinate how building pressurization is controlled and maintained.

Filtration. Filtration capabilities with in-room terminals are generally minimal. The cabinet and component assembly often provide very little ability to improve the filtration capability, although fan-coil-style terminal units commonly can handle better filtration. Manufacturer-supplied filters are often either washable or throwaway filters. Some manufacturers provide an option for a higher-quality pleated-style filter to be used, but their recommendations for motor selection should be obeyed. Maintenance instructions for washable filters should be carefully followed, to avoid filter impaction and reduced airflow; good filter maintenance improves sanitation and provides full airflow, ensuring full-capacity delivery. In most areas, ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 now requires filtration of MERV 8 or higher.

Heating and Cooling Coils. Coils in terminal units are usually available in one-, two-, three-, and sometimes four-row coils for cooling, and one- or two-row coils for heating. In units with untreated outdoor air, selecting coil and fin materials and coatings for longer life expectancy should be carefully considered (see Chapter 23). Only the building envelope and internal space heating and cooling loads need to be handled by in-room terminal units when outdoor air is adequately pretreated by a central system to a neutral air temperature of about 21°C. This pretreatment should reduce the size and cost of the terminal units. All loads must be considered in unit selection when outdoor air is introduced directly through building apertures into the terminal unit, as is sometimes done with unit ventilators. For cold climates, coil freeze protection must be considered.

Fan. Terminal units typically are not complex. Most modern units have ECM motors, a variable-speed drive (VSD), or other speed control on the fan.

Duct Distribution. Terminal units work best without extensive ductwork. With ducts, static pressure on the fan (instead of the coil capacity) may be the determining factor for sizing the terminal units, because multiple fan selections are not normally available.

Automatic Controls. Most terminal units are controlled with a standard electronic thermostat, either provided by the manufacturer or packaged by the automatic temperature controls (ATC) contractor. Thermostats capable of seven-day programming and night setback can improve energy savings where space usage is predictable enough to allow consistent programs. Terminal units can be incorporated into a BAS, but the cost to do so may be prohibitive, depending on the number of terminal units in the building. The potential operational cost savings, especially in facilities where a significant percentage of areas are often unoccupied, should be evaluated against the first-cost consideration.

Capacity Control. Terminal unit capacity is usually controlled by coil water or refrigerant flow, fan speed, or both. Water flow can be thermostatically controlled by return air temperature or a wall thermostat and two- or three-way valve. Unit controls may be a self-contained direct digital microprocessor, line voltage or low-voltage electric, or pneumatic. Fan speed control may be automatic or manual; automatic control is usually on/off, with manual speed selection. Room thermostats are preferred where automatic fan speed control is used. Return air thermostats do not give a reliable index of room temperature when the fan is off or when outdoor air is introduced nearby. Residential fan-coil units may have manual three-speed fan control, with water temperature (both heating and cooling) scheduled based on outdoor temperature. On/off fan control can be poor because (1) alternating shifts in fan noise level are more obvious than the sound of a constantly running fan, and (2) air circulation patterns in the room are noticeably affected. However, during cooling cycles, constant fan operation results in higher relative humidity levels than fan cycling, unless all latent load is handled by a primary central ventilation system.

For systems without primary central ventilation, summer room humidity levels tend to be relatively high, particularly if modulating chilled-water control valves are used for room temperature control. Alternatives are two-position control with variable-speed fans (chilled water is either on or off, and airflow is varied to maintain room temperature) and the bypass unit variable chilled-water temperature control (chilled-water flow is constant, and face and bypass dampers are modulated to control room temperature).

The designer must be careful to understand the unit's operating conditions for the vast majority of the operation hours, and how the unit will actually perform at those times. Many manufacturers publish sensible and latent capacity information that is developed from testing at a single set of conditions (generally the AHRI standard condition), then use computer modeling or extrapolation rather than actual testing to determine operation capacities at other conditions. In most situations, the unit's actual operation for the vast majority of time is at conditions other than the rating condition. Additionally, control choices for water flow or airflow may create conditions different from those used by the manufacturer to determine the published operation

capacities. Because peak conditions are often used to select coils but in most applications only occur a small percentage of the time, oversizing of coils and loss of humidity control become common if these issues are not carefully thought through during design and selection of the equipment.

Configurations

Terminal units are available in many different configurations; however, not all configurations are available for all types of terminal units. The designer should evaluate the air pathways of the specific units being considered, because some allow raw outdoor air to bypass the filter and/or the coils. Additionally, on some unit ventilators with face and bypass, the raw outdoor air is allowed to stratify in the bypass section, again bypassing the coils. Depending on climate conditions and filtration requirements, these configurations may not be appropriate.

Low-profile vertical units are available for use under windows with low sills; however, in some cases, the low silhouette is achieved by compromising features such as filter area, motor serviceability, and cabinet style.

Floor-to-ceiling, **chase-enclosed units** are available in which the water and condensate drain risers are part of the factory-furnished unit. Stacking units with integral prefabricated risers directly one above the other can substantially reduce field labor for installation, an important cost factor. These units are used extensively in hotels and other residential buildings. For units serving multiple rooms (single-occupancy suite-type spaces), the supply and return air paths must be isolated from each other to prevent air and sound interchange between rooms.

Perimeter-located units give better results in climates or buildings with high heating requirements. Heating is enhanced by under-window or exterior wall locations. Vertical units with finned risers can operate as convectors with the fans turned off during night setback, and overheating can become an issue.

Horizontal overhead units may be fitted with ductwork on the discharge to supply several outlets. A single unit may serve several rooms (e.g., in an apartment house where individual room control is not essential and a common air return is feasible). Units must have larger fan motors designed to handle the higher static pressure resistance of the connected ductwork.

Horizontal models conserve floor space and usually cost less, but when located in furred ceilings, they can create problems such as condensate collection and disposal, mixing return air from other rooms, leaky pans damaging ceilings, and difficult access for filter and component removal. In addition, possible condensate leakage may present air quality concerns.

Other sections in this chapter discuss specific configurations for the type of unit, and indicate additional chapters in the volume that provide diagrams and additional information.

3. SECONDARY-WATER DISTRIBUTION

The secondary-water system includes the part of the water distribution system that circulates water to room terminal units when the water has been cooled or heated either by extraction from or heat exchange with another source in the primary circuit. In the primary circuit, water is cooled by flow through a chiller or is heated by a heat input source. Water flow through the in-room terminal unit coil performs secondary cooling or heating when the room air (secondary air) gives up or gains heat. Secondary-water system design differs for two- and four-pipe systems. Secondary-water systems are discussed in Chapter 13.

4. PIPING ARRANGEMENTS

For terminal units requiring chilled and/or hot water, the piping arrangement determines the performance characteristics, ease of operation, and initial cost of the system. Each piping arrangement is briefly discussed here; for further details, see Chapter 13.

Four-Pipe Distribution

Four-pipe distribution of secondary water has dedicated supply and return pipes for chilled and hot water. The four-pipe system generally has a high initial cost compared to a two-pipe system but has the best system performance. It provides (1) all-season availability of heating and cooling at each unit, (2) no summer/winter changeover requirement, (3) simpler operation, and (4) hot-water heating that uses any heating fuel, heat recovery, or solar heat. In addition, it can be controlled at the terminal unit to maintain a dead band between heating and cooling so simultaneous heating and cooling cannot occur.

Two-Pipe Distribution

Two-Pipe Changeover Without Central Ventilation. In this system, either hot or cold water is supplied through the same piping. The terminal unit has a single coil. The simplest system with the lowest initial cost is the two-pipe changeover with (1) outdoor air introduced through building apertures, (2) manual three-speed fan control, and (3) hot- and cold-water temperatures scheduled by outdoor temperatures. The changeover temperature is set at some predetermined set point. If a thermostat is used to control water flow, it must reverse its action depending on whether hot or cold water is available.

The two-pipe system cannot simultaneously provide heating and cooling, which may be required during intermediate seasons when some rooms need cooling and others need heat. This characteristic can be especially troublesome if a single piping zone supplies the entire building, but may be partly overcome by dividing the piping into zones based on solar exposure. Then each zone may be operated to heat or cool, independent of the others. However, one room may still require cooling while another room on the same solar exposure requires heating, particularly if the building is partially shaded by an adjacent building or tree.

Another system characteristic is the possible need for frequent changeover from heating to cooling, which complicates operation and increases energy consumption to the degree that it may become impractical. For example, two-pipe changeover system hydraulics must consider the water expansion (and relief) that occurs during cycling from cooling to heating.

Caution must be used when this system is applied to spaces with widely varying internal loads, and outdoor air is introduced through the terminal unit instead of through a central ventilation system. Continuous introduction of outdoor air when the load is reduced often results in sporadically unconditioned outdoor air, which can cause high space humidity levels, unless additional separate dehumidification or reheat is used. The outdoor air damper in the unit must be motor-operated so it can be closed during unoccupied periods when minimal conditioning is required.

The designer should consider the disadvantages of the two-pipe system carefully; many installations of this type waste energy and have been unsatisfactory in climates where frequent changeover is required, and where interior loads require cooling and exterior spaces simultaneously require heat. Most energy codes are difficult to meet with this system.

Two-Pipe Changeover with Partial Electric Strip Heat. This arrangement provides heating in intermediate seasons by using a small electric strip heater in the terminal unit. The unit can handle heating requirements in mild weather, typically down to 4°C, while continuing to circulate chilled water to handle any cooling requirements. When the outdoor temperature drops sufficiently to require heating beyond the electric strip heater capacity, the water system must be changed over to hot water. Most energy codes do not allow electric heating.

Two-Pipe Nonchangeover with Full Electric Strip Heat. This system may not be recommended for energy conservation, but it may be practical in areas with a small heating requirement or in other situations where life-cycle costs support this choice. Many energy codes will not allow this system unless energy analysis can prove compliance by life-cycle analysis.

Three-Pipe Distribution

Three-pipe distribution uses separate hot- and cold-water supply pipes. A common return pipe carries both hot and cold water back to the central plant. The terminal unit control introduces hot or cold water to the common unit coil based on the need for heating or cooling. This type of distribution is not recommended because of its energy inefficiency from constantly reheating and recooling water, and it does not comply with most recognized energy codes. Further, modern chillers and boilers cannot survive with the resultant changeover water temperatures.

Condenser Water Systems with Heat Pump Terminal Units

Condenser water systems are very similar to the two-pipe changeover with partial electric strip heat. The supply and return pipes carry water at more moderate temperatures than those of typical chilled or hot water. The heat pumps use the water as a heat source for heating and as a heat sink in cooling mode, allowing various in-room heat pumps to meet room needs during intermediate seasons. If additional heat is needed in a room, a small electric strip heater in the terminal unit can provide it, though this should be avoided for energy reasons. When the outdoor temperature drops sufficiently to require additional heating capacity, the water system must be changed over to hot water. Chapters 9, 14, and 48 contain additional information about condenser water piping systems and heat pumps.

5. FAN-COIL UNIT AND UNIT VENTILATOR SYSTEMS

Fan-coil units and unit ventilator systems are similar; their common traits and differences are discussed here. Both (1) can provide cooling as well as heating, (2) normally move air by forced convection through the conditioned space or fan-powered flow, (3) filter circulating air, and (4) may introduce outdoor ventilation air. Fan-coils are available in various configurations to fit under windowsills, above furred ceilings, in vertical pilasters built into walls, etc., whereas unit ventilators are available in three main configurations: floor-mounted below a window, horizontal overhead with ducted supply and return, and stacking vertical units. Fan-coils are often used in applications where ventilation requirements are minimal. Unit ventilators are similar, except that unit ventilators are designed to provide up to 100% outdoor air to the space.

Basic elements of both fan-coils and unit ventilators are a finned-tube heating/cooling coil, filter, and fan section (Figure 1). Unit ventilators can include a face-and-bypass damper. The fan recirculates air from the space through the coil, which contains either hot or chilled water or refrigerant. The unit may contain an additional electric resistance, steam, or hot-water heating coil, though these may be regulated by energy codes. The electric heater is often sized for fall and spring to avoid changeover problems in two-pipe systems; it may also provide reheat for humidity control. Due to comfort requirements and equipment capabilities, two-pipe systems are seldom used for new construction. A cleanable or replaceable moderate-efficiency filter upstream of the fan helps prevent clogging of the coil with dirt or lint entrained in recirculated air. It also helps protect the motor and fan, and can reduce the level of airborne contaminants in the conditioned space. Further, much higher filter efficiencies are recommended by ASHRAE standards and many energy codes. The fan and motor assembly is arranged for quick removal for servicing. The units generally are also equipped with an insulated drain pan.

Most manufacturers furnish units with cooling performance certified as meeting Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute (AHRI) standards. Unit prototypes have been tested and labeled by Underwriters Laboratories (UL) or Engineering Testing Laboratories (ETL), as required by some codes. Requirements for testing and standard rating of room fan-coils with air-delivery capacities of 708 L/s or below are described in AHRI *Standard* 440 and ASHRAE *Standard* 79. Requirements for testing and standard rating of room unit ventilators with air delivery capacities of 1416 L/s or below are described in AHRI *Standard* 840.

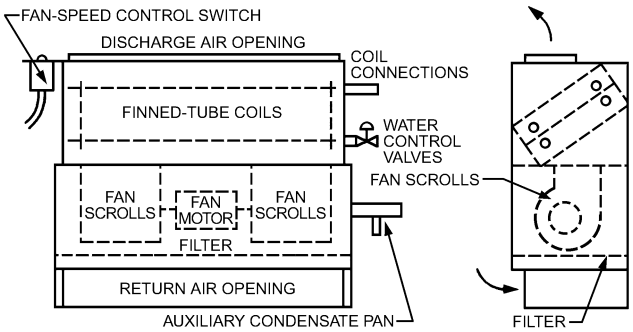
For the U.S. market, fan-coil units are generally available in nominal sizes of 95, 140, 190, 285, 375, 565, 755, and 945 L/s, and unit ventilators in nominal sizes of 350, 470, 700, and 940 L/s. Both types of units can often be purchased with multispeed, high-efficiency fan motors.

Types and Location

Floor-mounted units have various ventilation air ductwork connections, including from the back or a ducted collar on the top of the cabinet. **Ceiling-mounted** and **stacking units** can be mounted completely exposed, partially exposed in a soffit, fully recessed, or concealed. Ventilation air connections can be made in the back or top of the unit, as well as the side in some cases.

For existing building retrofit, it may be easier to install piping, outdoor air, and wiring for a terminal unit system than the large ductwork required for an all-air system. Common fan-coil system applications are hotels, motels, apartment buildings, and small office buildings and retail spaces. Fan-coil systems are used in many hospitals, but they are less desirable because of the low-efficiency filtration and difficulty in maintaining adequate cleanliness in the unit and enclosure. In addition, limits set by the American Institute of Architects' *Guidelines for Design and Construction of Hospital and Health Care Facilities* (AIA 2001) do not allow air recirculation in certain types of hospital spaces.

Unit ventilator systems are most frequently used in classrooms, which need a high percentage of outdoor air for proper ventilation. Unit ventilators are often located under a window along the perimeter wall. They are available in a two-pipe configuration with changeover, two-pipe with electric heating, four-pipe, or with heating and DX coils for spaces (e.g., computer rooms) that may require year-round cooling. Limited ductwork may be allowed, allowing for higher and often exposed ceiling systems. DX heat pump unit ventilators may be used in areas with wide variations in daily loads, such as deserts and areas near oceans. These units can often be misused as shelving in classroom; books and paperwork may be stacked



Unit ventilators use same/or similar components; see Chapter 28 for unit ventilator configurations.

Fig. 1 Typical Fan-Coil Unit

on top of them, impeding airflow to the space. Also, ventilation air intake louvers can become choked by vegetation if they are not properly maintained. In addition, because the fans are sized to accommodate 100% ventilation air, they are typically noisier than fan-coils, although recent developments have led to new units that are much quieter.

For existing building retrofit, it is easiest to replace unit ventilators in kind. If a building did not originally use unit ventilators, installing multiple ventilation air intake louvers to accommodate the unit ventilators may be cost prohibitive. Likewise, installing a different type of system in a building originally fitted with unit ventilators requires bricking up intake louvers and installing exposed ductwork (if there is no ceiling plenum) or creating a ceiling space in which to run ductwork. Unit ventilators are best applied where individual space temperature control with large amounts of ventilation air is needed.

Ventilation Air Requirements

Fan-coil and unit ventilators often receive ventilation air from a penetration in the outer wall or from a central air handler. Units that have outdoor air ducted to them from an aperture in the building envelope are not suitable for tall buildings because constant changes in wind pressure cause variations in the amount of outdoor air admitted. In this situation, ventilation rates can also be affected by stack effect, wind direction, and speed. Also, freeze protection may be required in cold climates, because preheating outdoor air is not possible. Historically, fan-coils have often been used in residential construction because of their simple operation and low first cost, and because residential rooms were often ventilated by opening windows or by outer wall apertures rather than a central system. Operable windows can cause imbalances with a ducted ventilation air system; current standards have moved toward requiring specific ventilation airflow control in residences, therefore minimizing the ability to use noncentralized ventilation systems, even in residential applications. In many cases, ventilation can be controlled by using an outdoor air fan with a high-efficiency filter.

Unlike fan-coils, unit ventilators can provide the entire volume of ventilation air that is required in many applications. The heating/cooling coils in unit ventilators therefore differ considerably from fan-coils. Coils in unit ventilators are much deeper, because the unit ventilator needs to be able to heat, cool, and dehumidify up to 100% ventilation air. Coil selection must be based on the temperature of the entering mixture of primary and recirculated air, and air leaving the coil must satisfy the room's sensible and latent cooling and heating requirements. If variable occupancy levels regularly occur during system operation hours, such as often occurs with classrooms, sizing a single unit for the fully occupied outdoor air requirement could result in oversized cooling capacity during many hours of operating time. This could result in loss of humidity control. For variable-occupancy applications, demand control ventilation or pretreated outdoor air is recommended.

Selection

Some designers select fan-coil units and unit ventilators for nominal cooling at medium speed when a three-speed control switch is provided, to enable quieter operation in the space and add a safety factor (sensible capacity can be increased by operating at high speed). Sound power ratings are available from many manufacturers.

If using a horizontal overhead unit with ducted supply and return, fan capacity may be the factor that decides the unit's size, not the coil's capacity. Static pressure as little as 75 Pa can significantly affect fan air volume and unit capacity.

If the unit is selected to provide full capacity at medium speed, the unit must also be able to handle the full volume of required ventilation air at that airflow, which is not an issue when using a supplemental outdoor air fan and filter. If cooling loads vary more than 20% during operation hours, it is highly likely this selection could result in oversized capacity operation and loss of humidity control. Current fan motor speed control options, such as electronically commutated motors (ECMs), and units designed to operate more quietly allow unit selection for the fan's full-speed total capacity, and minimize the chance of oversizing.

Wiring

Fan-coil and unit ventilator blower fans are driven by small motors. Fan-coil motors are generally shaded pole or capacitor start with inherent overload protection. Operating wattage of even the largest sizes rarely exceeds 300 W at high speed. Running current rarely exceeds 2.5 A. Unit ventilator motors are typically 0.4 kW or less. Operating power of even the largest sizes rarely exceeds 400 W at high speed. Almost all motors on units in the United States are 120 V, single-phase, 60 Hz current.

In planning the wiring circuit, follow all required codes. The preferred wiring method generally provides separate electrical circuits for fan-coil or unit ventilator units and does not connect them into the lighting circuit, or other power circuits. Separate wiring connections may be needed for condensate pumps.

Condensate

Even when outdoor air is pretreated, a condensate removal system must be installed for fan-coil units and unit ventilators. Drain pans should be integral for all units. For floor-mounted units along the perimeter of the building, condensate piping may run from the drain pan to the exterior grade, depending on the authorities having jurisdiction. Where drainage by gravity will not be sufficient, provide condensate pumps. Condensate drain lines should be properly sized and maintained to avoid clogging with dirt and other materials. Where approved and safe, use of plastic piping provides a safer drainage system with reduced clogging. Condensation may occur on the outside of drain piping, which requires that these pipes be insulated. Many building codes have outlawed systems without condensate drain piping because of the potential damage and possibility of mold growth in stagnant water accumulated in the drain pan.

Capacity Control

Fan-coil and unit ventilator capacity is usually controlled by coil water or refrigerant flow, fan speed, or a combination of these. In addition, unit ventilators often are available with a face-and-bypass damper, which allows for another form of capacity control. For additional information, see the discussion on capacity control in the section on System Components and Configurations.

Maintenance

Fan-coil and unit ventilator systems require more maintenance than central all-air systems, and the work must be done in occupied areas. Units operating at low dew points require regular (multiple times per year) cleaning and flushing of condensate pans and drains to prevent overflow and microbial build-up. Coils should be cleaned at least once a year, and more often when they consistently are removing moisture. The physical restraints of in-room terminal units located high in rooms or concealed in ceilings, soffits, etc., can create challenges for proper coil cleaning. Water valves, controls, and dampers should also be checked yearly for proper calibration, operation, and needed repairs.

Filters are small and low- to medium-efficiency, and require frequent changing to maintain air volume. Cleaning frequency varies with the application. Units in apartments, hotels, and hospitals usually require more frequent filter service because of lint. Unit motors may require periodic lubrication. Motor failures are not common, but when they occur, the entire fan can be quickly

replaced with minimal interruption in the conditioned space. More specialized motors with speed control devices may take several days to get a replacement, so large facilities should stock several spares for quick replacement to avoid significant down time for the unit. Chapters 20 and 28 provide more information on fan-coils and unit ventilators, respectively.

6. VARIABLE-REFRIGERANT-FLOW (VRF) UNITS

Technological advances in compressor design and control as well as use of electronically controlled expansion valves have allowed design of DX systems in which a single compressor unit provides refrigerant to multiple in-room terminal units. These types of systems are commonly called variable-refrigerant-flow (VRF) systems. Configuration of in-room units is similar to fan-coils, but uses a DX coil instead of water.

In these systems, refrigerant piping to terminal units is also called primary piping, and the compressor unit can often be more than 30 m from the in-room terminal units.

To allow heating to occur in one space while cooling occurs in an adjacent space, heat pump/heat recovery condensing units must be used and a set of three refrigerant pipes (suction, liquid, and hot gas) must be piped out into the building to the in-room terminal units, or two pipes to terminal units, which then distribute to three pipes. A reversing valve must be provided for each of the in-room terminal units, to allow them to use either liquid refrigerant to cool, or hot gas to heat. The specifics of long-run refrigerant piping are discussed further in Chapter 1 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*, and most manufacturers of these type of systems have very specific installation instructions that must be followed. As with any system that runs refrigerant piping through occupied areas of a building, ASHRAE *Standard* 15 must be complied with, as well.

VRF systems are discussed in more detail in Chapter 18.

7. CHILLED-BEAM SYSTEMS

Chilled beams are an evolution of chilled ceiling panels. Reports of energy savings over variable-air-volume (VAV) systems, especially in spaces with high concentrations of sensible loads (e.g., laboratories), have been touted in Europe and Australia. Applications such as health care, data centers, and some office areas may be well suited to chilled-beam systems.

Two types of chilled beams, passive and active, are in use (Figure 2). **Passive chilled beams** consist of a chilled-water coil mounted inside a cabinet. Chilled water is piped to the convective coil at between 14 and 15°C. Passive beams use convection currents to cool the space. As air that has been cooled by the beam's chilled-water coil falls into the space, warmer air is displaced, rises into the coil, and is cooled. Passive beams can provide approximately 1385 kJ/m and, to ensure proper dehumidification and effective ventilation to the spaces, require a separate ventilation system to provide tempered, dehumidified air. Heat can be provided by finned-tube radiation along the space perimeter. Overcooling must be avoided during cooling seasons, to prevent discomfort, condensation, and microbial growth in spaces. **Active chilled beams** can provide up to approximately 2750 kJ/m. They operate with induction nozzles that entrain room air and mix it with the primary or ventilation air that is ducted to the beam. Chilled water is piped to the coil at between 13 and 15°C. Primary air should be ducted to the beam at 13°C or lower to provide proper dehumidification. The primary air is then mixed with induced room air at a ratio of 1:2. For example, 24 L/s of primary air at 13°C may be mixed with 48 L/s of recirculated room air, and the active beam would distribute 70 L/s at around 18°C. If the low-temperature primary air alone will overcool spaces during any time of the year, there must be provision for reheat. Active beams can have either a two- or four-pipe distribution system. The two-pipe system may be cooling only or two-pipe changeover. Active beams can be designed to heat and cool the occupied space, but finned-tube radiation is still commonly used to provide heating in a space that is cooled with active beams.

Both active and passive beams are designed to operate dry, without condensate. In some models of active beams, a drain pan may be available if the coil is in a vertical configuration. Horizontal coils in passive beams cannot have drain pans, because the area directly below the coil is needed to allow the air in the convection current to circulate. Chilled beams can be used in various applications; however, they are best used in applications with high sensible loads, such as laboratory spaces with high internal heat gains. See manufacturers' information for beam cooling capacities at various water temperatures and flow rates. Several manufacturers have design guides available on the Internet.

The latest generation of chilled beams is multiservice: they can be either passive or active, and combine building operations such as lighting, security sensors, motion detectors, sprinkler systems, smoke detectors, intercoms, and power or fiber-optic distribution with the chilled beam. Proper implementation requires extensive integrated building design.

Types and Location

Passive beams are available in sections up to 3 m long and 460 to 610 mm wide. They can be located above the ceiling with perforated panels below it, mounted into the frame of an acoustical tile ceiling, or mounted in the conditioned space. The perforated panels must have a minimum 50% free area and extend beyond either side of the beam for usually half of the unit's width, so the convection current is not hindered. Also, care must be taken to not locate passive beams too close to window treatments, which can also hinder air movement around the beam.

Active beams are available in sections up to 3 m long and 300 to 610 mm wide. They can be mounted into the frame of an acoustical tile ceiling or in the conditioned space.

Ventilation Air Requirements

Passive beams require a separate ventilation system to provide tempered and dehumidified air to the space. The ventilation air should be ducted to low-wall diffusers or in an underfloor distribution system so that the ventilation air does not disturb the convection currents in the conditioned space. Ventilation air can be ducted directly into the active beams. If more ventilation air is needed to meet the space requirements, the volume of air can be split by the active beams and high-induction diffusers. Care must be taken in selecting diffuser locations to coordinate well with the convective currents required by the chilled beams.

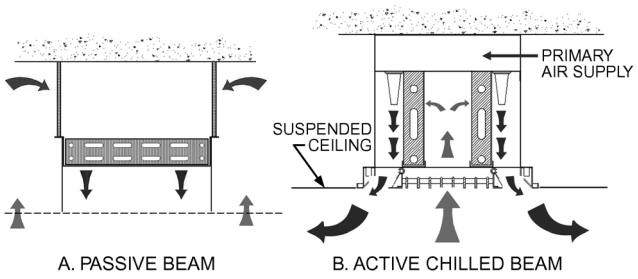


Fig. 2 Passive and Active Chilled-Beam Operation

(Courtesy of Trox USA, Inc.)

Selection

Chilled beams are selected based on the calculated heat gain for the space less the cooling effect of the primary ventilation air.

Wiring

Chilled beams only require controls wiring. There is no fan or other electrical equipment to be wired.

Condensate

Chilled beams are designed to operate dry, with few exceptions. In some active beams with vertical coils, a drain pan may be installed. However, as a rule, a separate ventilation system should be sized to handle the latent cooling load in the space, and the relative humidity should be closely monitored. If the primary ventilation system fails to properly control the space humidity, condensation may form on the beams and their housings. Dripping of this condensate could damage building materials and contents.

Chilled-water valves should have drain pans to contain any normal condensate that occurs, when the space is properly dehumidified. In case of loss of humidity control of the space, unpiped condensate drain pans will not be sufficient to avoid overflows and damage.

Capacity Control

Capacity of the chilled beam is controlled by a two-way valve on the chilled-water pipe, which is wired to a room thermostat. There is typically one valve per zone (e.g., office, lecture hall). Beams should be piped directly in a reverse/return piping design. Beams are not typically piped in series.

Maintenance

Maintenance on chilled beams requires blowing off the coils on a regular basis. Because coils are located throughout occupied spaces, this requires some coordination with occupants and housekeeping personnel to minimize effects on furniture and space contents.

Other Concerns

Consistent air movement with natural convection equipment is difficult to achieve. The designer should consult with the manufacturer to determine the proper spacing of chilled beams based on ceiling height, heat generation sources, occupant locations, and movement patterns. Prevention of cold air ponding on the floor, especially when heat sources vary, can be paramount in maintaining comfort.

Occupant comfort is affected by more than temperature and humidity. Noise levels and nonstagnant air are also important. Some spaces may not achieve sufficient air movement or background noise to allow occupant comfort through use of passive chilled beams. Additionally, insufficient filtration of the air may occur without sufficient air movement and filtration devices in the space.

When introducing pretreated ventilation air to a space, be careful not to interfere with convection currents while still complying with the requirements of ventilation effectiveness and efficiency.

8. RADIANT-PANEL HEATING SYSTEMS

Radiant heating panels can use either hot water or electricity. The panels are manufactured in standard 300 by 300 or 300 by 1220 mm panels that can be mounted into the frame of an acoustical tile ceiling or directly to an exposed ceiling or wall. Radiant panels are designed for all types of applications. They are energy efficient, providing a comfortable heat without lowering the moisture content of the room air the way heated air systems may. Occupants in a space heated by radiant heat are comfortable at lower room temperatures, which frequently reduces operational costs. See Chapter 6 for more information on these systems. Electric panels may be regulated by local energy codes.

Types and Location

Radiant panels are typically mounted on the ceiling near perimeter walls in a metal frame. Unlike finned-tube radiation, they do not limit furniture placement. Electric radiant panels are available from 250 to 750 W in standard single-phase voltages.

Ventilation Air Requirements

Radiant panels provide space heating. Ventilation air must be supplied by a central ventilation unit that can provide tempered, humidity-controlled air to the space.

Selection

Radiant panels are selected based on the calculated heat loss for the space.

Wiring

Electric radiant panels are available in standard single-phase voltages. Panels are often prewired, including the ground wire, with lead wires housed in flexible metal conduit and connector for junction box mounting.

Capacity Control

Panel capacity is usually controlled by coil water flow, or in the case of electric heat, capacity steps. Most radiant panels are controlled with a wall-mounted thermostat located in the space.

Maintenance

Because they have no moving parts, radiant panels require little maintenance. Water flow control valves require periodic verification that they are operating correctly.

9. RADIANT-FLOOR HEATING SYSTEMS

Radiant-floor heat is best applied under a finished floor that is typically cold to the touch. Radiant-floor heat systems in the past used flexible copper pipe heating loops encased in concrete. Unfortunately, the soldered joints could fail or the concrete's expansion and contraction or chemical composition could corrode the pipes, causing them to leak. However, new technologies include flexible plastic tubing (often referred to as PEX, or cross-linked polyethylene) to replace the old flexible copper tubing. PEX tubing is also available with an oxygen diffusion barrier, because oxygen entrained in the radiant heat tubing can cause corrosion on the ferrous connectors between the tubing and the manifold system. PEX tubing is also available in longer lengths than the flexible copper, which minimizes buried joints. The tubing is run back to a manifold system, which includes valves to balance and shut down the system and a small circulator pump. Multiple zones can be terminated at the same manifold.

Historically, radiant-floor heat was commonly designed for residential applications, when ventilation was provided by operable windows, and cooling was not mandatory. Like most other in-room terminal systems, the required ventilation air must be supplied by a central unit that can provide tempered and humidity-controlled air that allows comfort conditions in the space to be met. Common applications of radiant-floor heat systems include large open buildings, such as airplane hangars, where providing heat at the floor is more cost-effective than heating the entire volume of air in the space. Radiant-floor heat is becoming more common for preschools, elementary schools, exercise spaces, and other locations where children or adults sit or lie on floors. Water in the radiant-floor loop is often around 32°C, depending on the floor finish. This is a lower temperature than forced hot-air systems, and reduces the energy required to heat the building. Buildings that have high ceilings, large windows, or high infiltration rates or that require high air change rates may save energy by using radiant-floor heat.

Radiant-floor systems are commonly zoned by room. Each room may require multiple pipe circuits, depending on the room's area and the manifold's location. Maximum tubing lengths are determined based on tubing diameter and desired heat output. If tubing is installed in a slab on or below grade or over an unconditioned space, insulation should be incorporated to minimize heat losses. If a radiant-floor heat system is installed in a slab over a conditioned space, the radiant effect on that space must be considered as well.

See Chapter 6 for more information on radiant panel heating systems.

Types and Location

Radiant-floor heating is located in the flooring or just below it with a heat-reflecting wrap. If the final floor finish is hardwood flooring, the radiant-floor piping can be installed in plywood tracks with a heat reflector, below the finished floor. Ensure that, as the final flooring is nailed down, the flexible tubing is not punctured. If the final floor is a ceramic tile or other surface requiring a poured concrete, the radiant floor can be laid out in the concrete, if hot-water systems are being used. Electric underfloor heating is also available, using a prefabricated mat that is applied on top of the subfloor and under with ceramic tile. Radiant-floor heating systems can also be mounted below the floor joists, with a heat reflector below the piping. This method is often used in renovations where removing existing flooring is not feasible.

Ventilation Air Requirements

Ventilation air must be supplied by a central ventilation unit that can provide tempered, humidity-controlled air to the space.

Selection

Spacing between rows of tubing that make up the radiant floor varies, depending on the heat loss of the space. Usually, the entire heat loss of the space is calculated and the tubing spaced accordingly. Another method is to place tubing closer together near the room's perimeter and increase the spacing in the interior. This method is more time consuming, and the difference is only noticeable in large spaces. Supply water temperature in the tubing is determined based on the flooring materials' resistance to heat flow; the temperature is higher for carpeting and a pad than for ceramic tile. The tubing is also available in different nominal diameters, the most common being 10 or 13 mm.

Wiring

Circulator pumps at the manifolds require power. Additional controls for zone control valves may be selected for either line voltage or low voltage.

Capacity Control

Because radiant floors heat the mass of the floor, these systems are typically slow to respond to environmental changes. The circulator pumps start on a call for heat from a thermostat; however, rapid solar gains to a space with many windows could cause the space to overheat. Smart systems have been used to anticipate the needs of the space and overcome the thermal flywheel effects inherent to these types of systems. Smart systems anticipate the need for heating based on outdoor conditions and the conditions experienced in the recent past. They anticipate when set-point temperatures are about to be achieved and reduce heat generation, to minimize overshooting. They also learn patterns of operation that help overcome reasonably consistent daily solar gains.

Maintenance

The circulator pumps, valves, controls, and manifolds are the only components requiring maintenance. Once the tubing is laid out, it should be pressure-tested for leaks; once covered, it is extremely difficult and/or expensive to access.

10. INDUCTION UNIT SYSTEMS

Induction units are very similar to active chilled beams, although they have mostly been replaced by VAV systems. Only the specific differences of higher-pressure air induction units will be discussed here. Primary air is supplied to an induction unit's plenum at medium to high pressure. The acoustically treated plenum attenuates part of the noise generated in the unit and duct. High-velocity induction unit nozzles typically generate significant high-frequency noise. A balancing damper adjusts the primary-air quantity within limits.

Medium- to high-velocity air flows through the induction nozzles and induces secondary air from the room through the secondary coil. This secondary air is either heated or cooled at the coil, depending on the season, room requirement, or both. Ordinarily, the room coil does no latent cooling, but a drain pan without a piped drain collects condensed moisture from temporary latent loads such as at start-up. This condensed moisture then reevaporates when the temporary latent loads are no longer present. Primary and secondary (induced) air is mixed and discharged to the room.

Secondary airflow can cause induction-unit coils to become dirty enough to affect performance. Lint screens are sometimes used to protect these terminals, but require frequent in-room maintenance and reduce unit thermal performance.

Induction units are installed in custom enclosures, or in standard cabinets provided by the manufacturer. These enclosures must allow proper flow of secondary air and discharge of mixed air without imposing excessive pressure loss. They must also allow easy servicing. Although induction units are usually installed under a window at a perimeter wall, units designed for overhead installation are also available. During the heating season, the floor-mounted induction unit can function as a convector during off hours, with hot water to the coil and without a primary-air supply. Numerous induction unit configurations are available, including units with low overall height or with larger secondary-coil face areas to suit particular space or load needs.

Induction units may be noisier than fan-coil units, especially in frequencies that interfere with speech. On the other hand, white noise from the induction unit enhances acoustical privacy by masking speech from adjacent spaces.

In-room terminals operate dry, with an anticipated life of 15 to 25 years. Individual induction units do not contain fans, motors, or compressors. Routine service is generally limited to temperature controls, cleaning lint screens, and infrequently cleaning the induction nozzles.

In existing induction systems, conserving energy by raising the chilled-water temperature on central air-handling cooling coils can damage the terminal cooling coil, causing it to be used constantly as a dehumidifier. Unlike fan-coil units, the induction unit is not designed or constructed to handle condensation. Therefore, it is critical that an induction terminal operates dry.

Induction units are rarely used in new construction. They consume more energy because of the increased power needed to deliver primary air against the pressure drop in the terminal units, and they generate high-frequency noise from the induction nozzles. In addition, the initial cost for a four-pipe induction system is greater than for most all-air systems. However, induction units are still used for direct replacement renovation; because the architecture was originally designed to accommodate the induction unit, other systems may not be easily installed.

11. SUPPLEMENTAL HEATING UNITS

In-room supplemental heating units come in all sizes. Units can have either electric (if allowed by local energy code) or hot-water

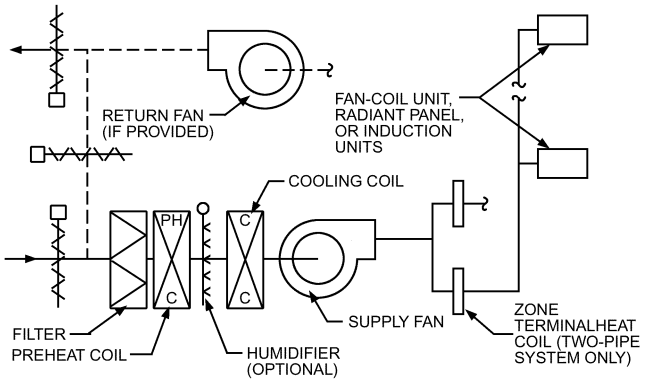


Fig. 3 Primary-Air System

heat, and sometimes steam; they can be surface-mounted, semirecessed, or recessed in the walls on the floor or horizontally along the ceiling. Baseboard radiation is usually located at the source of the heat loss, such as under a window or along a perimeter wall, and is usually rated for between 1400 and 2075 kJ/m at 77°C. Other supplemental heating units include unit heaters, wall heaters, and cabinet heaters.

All supplemental heating units can be supplied with an integral or separate wall-mounted thermostat. If the heater is located low in the space, an integral thermostat is sufficient most of the time; however, if the unit is mounted horizontally near the ceiling, the thermostat should be wired so that it is located in the space, for accurate space temperature readings. In addition, units may have a summer fan option, which allows the fan to turn on for ventilation. Water flow to space supplemental heaters should be cut off anytime the water temperature to the coil is below 27°C, to avoid condensation and consequent damage or mold growth.

12. PRIMARY-AIR SYSTEMS

Figure 3 illustrates a primary-air system for in-room terminal systems. The components are described in Chapter 4. Some primary-air systems operate with 100% outdoor air at all times. In climates where moisture content is lower outdoors than indoors, systems using return air may benefit from a provision for operating with 100% outdoor air (economizer cycle) to reduce operating cost during some seasons. In some systems, when the quantity of primary air supplied exceeds the ventilation or exhaust required, excess air is recirculated by a return system common with the interior system. A good-quality filter (MERV = 8 to 11) is desirable in the central air treatment apparatus. If it is necessary to maintain a given humidity level in cold weather, a humidifier can usually be installed. Where humidification is needed, steam humidifiers have been used successfully. Water-spray humidifiers must be operated in conjunction with (1) the preheat coil elevating the temperature of the incoming air or (2) heaters in the spray water circuit. Water-spray humidifiers should be used with caution, however, because of the possible growth of undesirable organisms in untreated water. See Chapter 22 for additional information on humidifiers.

The primary-air quantity is fixed, and the leaving primary-air temperature varies inversely with the outdoor temperature to provide the necessary amount of heating or cooling and humidity control. Proper leaving-air temperature must be determined based on climatic conditions and the influence of the ventilation air quantity on the final space temperature and relative humidity. In cooling season, many climates require primary air to be cooled to a point low enough to dehumidify the total system (cooling coil leaving temperature about 10°C or less, and almost completely saturated) and then reheated to be provided at an appropriate temperature and humidity level. During winter, primary air is often preheated and supplied at approximately 10°C to provide cooling. All room terminals in a given primary-air preheated zone must be selected to operate satisfactorily with the common primary-air temperature.

The supply fan should be selected at a point near maximum efficiency to reduce power consumption, supply air heating, and noise. Sound absorbers may be required at the fan discharge to attenuate fan noise.

Reheat coils are required in a two-pipe system. Reheat may not be required for primary-air supply of four-pipe systems. Formerly, many primary-air distribution systems for induction units were designed with 2.0 to 2.5 kPa (gage) static pressure. With energy use restrictions, this is no longer economical. Good duct design and elimination of unnecessary restrictions (e.g., sound traps) can result in primary systems that operate at 1.1 to 1.5 kPa (gage) or even lower. Low-initial-cost, smaller ductwork has to be weighed against operating costs during life-cycle evaluation, to provide a system that best meets the owner's long-term goals. Primary-air distribution systems serving fan-coil systems can operate at pressures 0.25 to 0.37 kPa or lower. Induction units and active chilled beams require careful selection of the primary-air cooling coil and the induction unit nozzles to achieve an overall medium-pressure primary-air system. Primary-air system distribution that is independently supplied to spaces for use with other in-room terminal systems may be low-velocity or a combination of low- and medium-velocity systems. See Chapter 21 in the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for a discussion of duct design. Variations in pressure between the first and last terminals should be minimized to limit the pressure drop required across balancing dampers.

Room sound characteristics vary depending on unit selection, air system design, and equipment manufacturer. Select units by considering the unit manufacturer's sound power ratings, desired maximum room noise level, and the room's acoustical characteristics. Limits of sound power level can then be specified to obtain acceptable acoustical performance. See Chapter 8 in the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals.*

13. PERFORMANCE UNDER VARYING LOAD

Under peak load conditions, the psychrometrics of induction units, chilled beams, unit ventilators, and fan-coil unit systems are essentially identical for two- and four-pipe systems. Primary air mixes with secondary air conditioned by the room coil in an induction unit before delivery to a room. Mixing also occurs in a fan-coil unit with a direct-connected primary-air supply. If primary air is supplied to the space separately, as in fan-coil systems with independent primary-air supplies, the same effect occurs in the space.

During cooling, the primary-air system provides part of the sensible capacity and all of the dehumidification. The rest of the sensible capacity is accomplished by the cooling effect of secondary water circulating through the in-room terminal unit cooling coils. In winter, when primary air is provided directly into the in-room terminal unit, it can be provided at a low temperature and humidified if necessary. This may allow cooling of internal spaces solely by the primary air, if quantities are sufficient to meet the full cooling requirements. Room heating where needed is then supplied by the secondary-water system circulating through the in-room terminal unit coils.

If the economizer cycle is used, cooling energy can be reduced when the moisture level of the outdoor air allows. For systems where primary air does not enter at the terminal unit, the primary air should enter the room at a temperature approximately neutral with the desired room condition and a relative humidity level that enhances room conditions. In buildings where cooling is required during heating conditions, care must be taken to avoid drafts caused by providing primary air at too low a temperature.

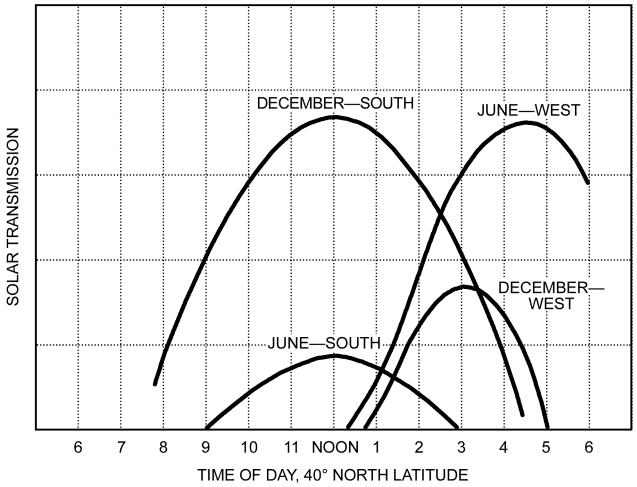


Fig. 4 Solar Radiation Variations with Seasons

If interior spaces require cooling, a four-pipe system should be considered to allow cooling of those areas while heating exterior perimeter zones. During fall and spring months, the primary-air temperature may be reduced slightly to provide the limited amount of cooling needed for east and west exposures with low internal heat gains, because solar heat gain is typically reduced during these seasons. In the northern hemisphere, the north exposure is not a significant factor because solar gain is very low; for south, southeast, and southwest exposures, the peak solar heat gain occurs in winter, coincident with a lower outdoor temperature (Figure 4). Reducing the primary-air temperature may not be a viable alternative where primary air is supplied directly to the space, because this air could overcool spaces where solar heat gain or internal heat gain is low.

In buildings with large areas of glass, heat transmitted from indoors to the outdoors, coupled with the normal supply of cool primary air, does not balance internal heat and solar gains until an outdoor temperature well below freezing is reached. Double-glazed windows with clear or heat-absorbing glass aggravate this condition, because this type of glass increases the heating effect of the radiant energy that enters during the winter by reducing reverse transmission. Therefore, cooling must be available at lower outdoor temperatures. In buildings with very high internal heat gains from lighting or equipment, the need for cooling from the room coil, as well as from the primary air, can extend well into winter. In any case, the changeover temperature at which the cooling capacity of the secondary-water system is no longer required for a given space is an important calculation. All these factors should be considered when determining the proper changeover temperature.

14. CHANGEOVER TEMPERATURE

For all systems using a primary-air system for outdoor air, there is an outdoor temperature (**balance temperature**) at which secondary cooling is no longer required. The system can cool by using outdoor air at lower temperatures. For all-air systems operating with up to 100% outdoor air, mechanical cooling is seldom required at outdoor temperatures below 12°C, unless the dew point of the outdoor air equals or exceeds the desired indoor dew point. An important characteristic of in-room terminal unit systems, however, is that secondary-water cooling may still be needed, even when the outdoor temperature is considerably less than 10°C. This cooling may be provided by the mechanical refrigeration unit or by a thermal economizer cycle. Full-flow circulation of primary air through the cooling coil below 10°C often provides all the necessary cooling while preventing coil freeze-up and reducing the preheat requirement. Alternatively, secondary-water-to-condenser-water heat exchangers function well.

The outdoor temperature at which the heat gain to every space can be satisfied by the combination of cold primary air and the transmission loss is called the **changeover temperature**. Below this temperature, cooling is not required.

The following empirical equation approximates the changeover temperature at sea level. It should be fine-tuned after system installation (Carrier 1965):

$$t_{co} = t_r - \frac{q_{is} + q_{es} - 1.2Q_p(t_r - t_p)}{\Delta q_{td}} \quad (1)$$

where

t_{co} = temperature of changeover point, °C
t_r = room temperature at time of changeover, normally 22°C
t_p = primary-air temperature at unit after system is changed over, normally 13°C
Q_p = primary-air quantity, L/s
q_{is} = internal sensible heat gain, W
q_{es} = external sensible heat gain, W
Δq_{td} = heat transmission per degree of temperature difference between room and outdoor air

In two-pipe changeover systems, the entire system is usually changed from winter to summer operation at the same time, so the room with the lowest changeover point should be identified. In northern latitudes, this room usually has a south, southeast, or southwest exposure because the solar heat gains on these exposures reach their maximum during winter.

If the calculated changeover temperature is below approximately 9°C, an economizer cycle should operate to allow the refrigeration plant to shut down.

Although factors controlling the changeover temperature of in-room terminal systems are understood by the design engineer, the basic principles may not be readily apparent to system operators. Therefore, it is important that the concept and calculated changeover temperature are clearly explained in operating instructions given before operating the system. Some increase from the calculated changeover temperature is normal in actual operation. Also, a range or band of changeover temperatures, rather than a single value, is necessary to preclude frequent change in seasonal cycles and to grant some flexibility in operation. The difficulties associated with operator understanding and the need to perform changeover several times a day in many areas have severely limited the acceptability of the two-pipe changeover system.

15. TWO-PIPE SYSTEMS WITH CENTRAL VENTILATION

Two-pipe systems for in-room terminal systems derive their name from the water-distribution circuit, which consists of one supply and one return pipe. Each unit or conditioned space is supplied with secondary water from this distribution system and with conditioned primary air from a central apparatus. The system design and control of primary-air and secondary-water temperatures must be such that all rooms on the same system (or zone, if applicable) can be satisfied during both heating and cooling seasons. The heating or cooling capacity of any unit at a particular time is the sum of its primary-air output plus its secondary-water output.

The secondary-water coil (cooling-heating) in each space is controlled by a space thermostat and can vary from 0 to 100% of coil capacity, as required to maintain space temperature. The secondary water is cold in summer and intermediate seasons and warm in winter. All rooms on the same secondary-water zone must operate satisfactorily with the same water temperature.

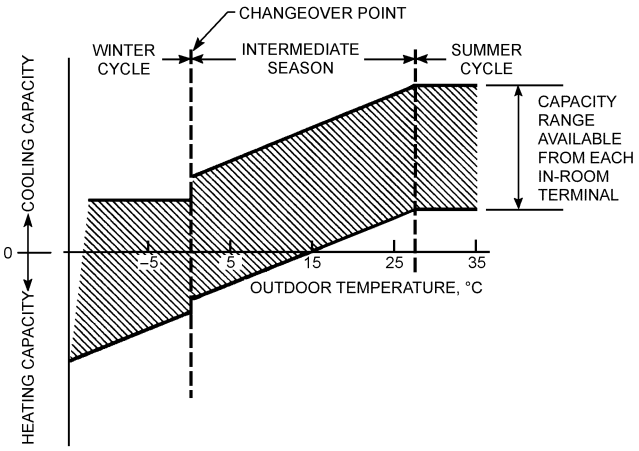


Fig. 5 Capacity Ranges of In-Room Terminal Operating on Two-Pipe System

Figure 5 shows the capacity ranges available from a typical two-pipe system. On a hot summer day, loads from about 25 to 100% of the design space cooling capacity can be satisfied. On a 10°C intermediate-season day, the unit can satisfy a heating requirement by closing off the secondary-water coil and using only the output of warm primary air. A lesser heating or net cooling requirement is satisfied by the cold secondary-water coil output, which offsets the warm primary air to obtain cooling. In winter, the unit can provide a small amount of cooling by closing the secondary coil and using only the cold primary air. Smaller cooling loads and all heating requirements are satisfied by using warm secondary water.

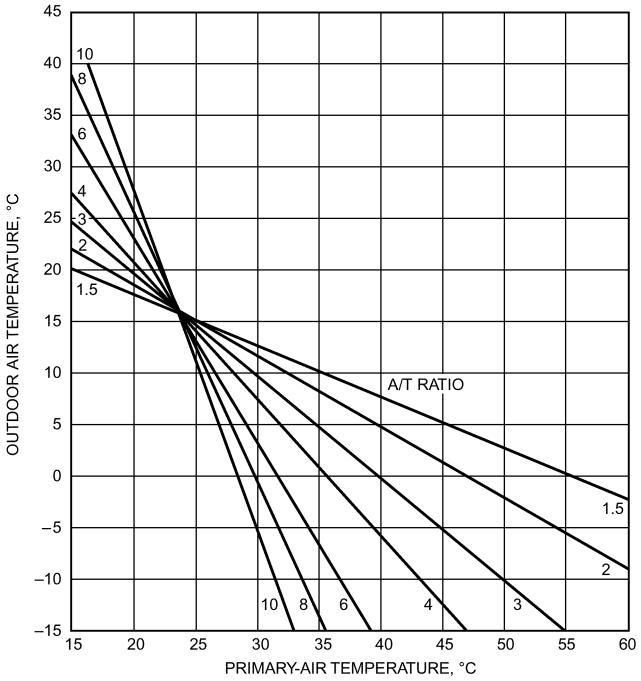
Critical Design Elements

The most critical design elements of a two-pipe system are the calculation of primary-air quantities and the final adjustment of the primary-air temperature reset schedule. All rooms require a minimum amount of heat and latent capacity from the primary-air supply during the intermediate season. Using the ratio of primary air to transmission per degree (A/T ratio) to maintain a constant relationship between the primary-air quantity and the heating requirements of each space fulfills this need. The A/T ratio determines the primary-air temperature and changeover point, and is fundamental to proper design and operation of a two-pipe system.

Transmission per Degree. The relative heating requirement of every space is determined by calculating the transmission heat flow per degree temperature difference between the space temperature and the outdoor temperature (assuming steady-state heat transfer). This is the sum of the (1) glass heat transfer coefficient times the glass areas, (2) wall heat transfer coefficient times the wall area, and (3) roof heat transfer coefficient times the roof area.

Air-to-Transmission (A/T) Ratio. The A/T ratio is the ratio of the primary airflow to a given space divided by the transmission per degree of that space: A/T ratio = Primary air/Transmission per degree.

Spaces on a common primary-air zone must have approximately the same A/T ratios. The design base A/T ratio establishes the primary-air reheat schedule during intermediate seasons. Spaces with A/T ratios higher than the design base A/T ratio tend to be overcooled during light cooling loads at an outdoor temperature in the 21 to 32°C range, whereas spaces with an A/T ratio lower than design lack sufficient heat during the 5 to 15°C outdoor temperature range when primary air is warm for heating and secondary water is cold for cooling.



Note: These temperatures are required at the units, and thermostat settings must be adjusted to allow for duct heat gains or losses. Temperatures are based on

1. Minimum average load in the space, equivalent to 5 K multiplied by the transmission per degree.
2. Preventing the room temperature from dropping below 22°C. These values compensate for the radiation and convection effect of the cold outside wall.

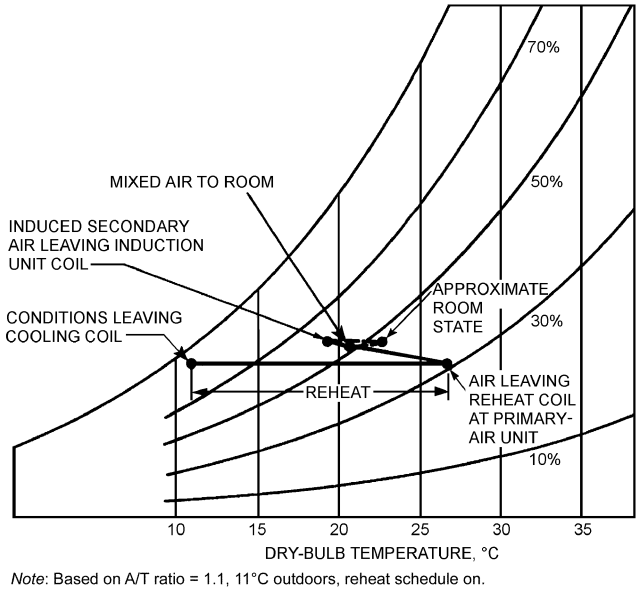
Fig. 6 Primary-Air Temperature Versus Outdoor Air Temperature

The minimum primary-air quantity that satisfies the requirements for ventilation, dehumidification, and both summer and winter cooling is used to calculate the minimum A/T ratio for each space. If the system operates with primary-air heating during cold weather, the heating capacity can also be the primary-air quantity determinant for two-pipe systems.

The design base A/T ratio is the highest A/T ratio obtained, and the primary airflow to each space is increased as required to obtain a uniform A/T ratio in all spaces. An alternative approach is to locate the space with the highest A/T ratio requirement by inspection, establish the design base A/T ratio, and obtain the primary airflow for all other spaces by multiplying this A/T ratio by the transmission per degree of all other spaces.

For each A/T ratio, there is a specific relationship between outdoor air temperature and temperature of the primary air that maintains the room at 22°C or more during conditions of minimum room cooling load. Figure 6 illustrates this variation based on an assumed minimum room load equivalent to 5 K times the transmission per degree. A primary-air temperature over 50°C at the unit is seldom used. The reheat schedule should be adjusted for hospital rooms or other applications where a higher minimum room temperature is desired, or where a space has no minimum cooling load.

Deviation from the A/T ratio is sometimes permissible. A minimum A/T ratio equal to 0.7 of the maximum A/T is suitable, if the building is of massive construction with considerable heat storage effect (Carrier 1965). The heating performance when using warm primary air becomes less satisfactory than that for systems with a uniform A/T ratio. Therefore, systems designed for A/T ratio deviation should be suitable for changeover to warm secondary water



Note: Based on A/T ratio = 1.1, 11°C outdoors, reheat schedule on.

Fig. 7 Psychrometric Chart, Two-Pipe System, Off-Season Cooling

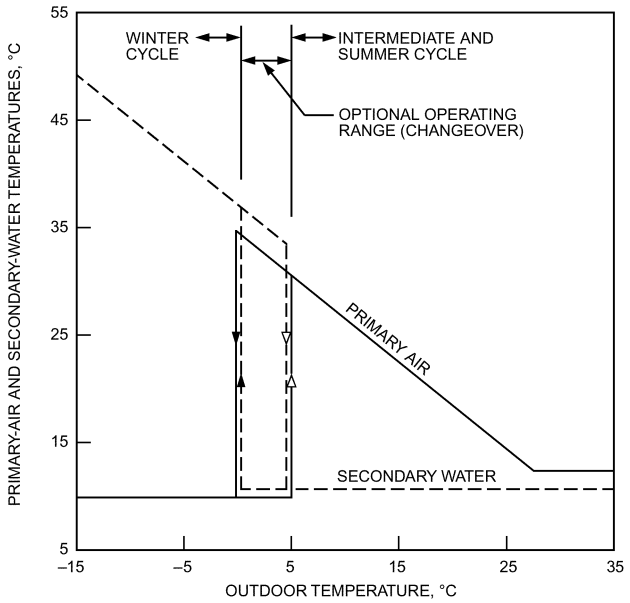


Fig. 8 Typical Changeover System Temperature Variation

for heating whenever the outdoor temperature falls below 5°C. A/T ratios should be more closely maintained on buildings with large glass areas or with curtain wall construction, or on systems with low changeover temperature.

Changeover Temperature Considerations

Transition from summer operations to intermediate-season operation is done by gradually raising the primary-air temperature as the outdoor temperature falls, to keep rooms with small cooling loads from becoming too cold. The secondary water remains cold during both summer and intermediate seasons. Figure 7 illustrates the psychrometrics of summer operation near the changeover temperature. As the outdoor temperature drops further, the changeover temperature is reached. The secondary-water system can then be changed over to provide hot water for heating.

If the primary airflow is increased to some spaces to elevate the changeover temperature, the A/T ratio for the reheat zone is affected. Adjustments in primary-air quantities to other spaces on that zone will probably be necessary to establish a reasonably uniform ratio.

System changeover can take several hours and usually temporarily upsets room temperatures. Good design, therefore, includes provision for operating the system with either hot or cold secondary water over a range of 8 to 11 K below the changeover point. This range makes it possible to operate with warm air and cold secondary water when the outdoor temperature rises above the daytime changeover temperature. Changeover to hot water is limited to times of extreme or protracted cold weather.

Optional hot- or cold-water operation below the changeover point is provided by increasing the primary-air reheater capacity to provide adequate heat at a colder outdoor temperature. Figure 8 shows temperature variation for a system operating with changeover, indicating the relative temperature of the primary air and secondary water throughout the year and the changeover temperature range. The solid arrows show the temperature variation when changing over from the summer to the winter cycle. The open arrows show the variation when going from the winter to the summer cycle.

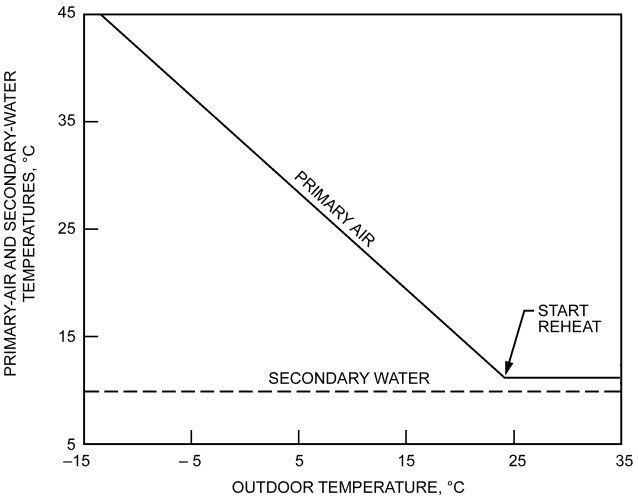


Fig. 9 Typical Nonchangeover System Variations

Nonchangeover Design

Consider using nonchangeover systems to simplify operation for buildings with mild winter climates, or for south exposure zones of buildings with a large winter solar load. A nonchangeover system operates on an intermediate-season cycle throughout the heating season, with cold secondary water to the terminal unit coils and with warm primary air satisfying all the heating requirements. Typical temperature variation is shown in Figure 9.

Spaces may be heated during unoccupied hours by operating the primary-air system with 100% return air. This feature is necessary because nonchangeover design does not usually include the ability to heat the secondary water. In addition, cold secondary water must be available throughout the winter. Primary-air duct insulation and observance of close A/T ratios for all units are essential for proper heating during cold weather.

Zoning

A two-pipe system can provide good temperature control most of the time, on all exposures during the heating and cooling seasons. Comfort and operating cost can be improved by zoning in the following ways:

- Primary air to allow different A/T ratios on different exposures
- Primary air to allow solar compensation of primary-air temperature
- Both air and water to allow a different changeover temperature for different exposures

All spaces on the same primary-air zone must have the same A/T ratio. The minimum A/T ratios often are different for spaces on different solar exposures, thus requiring the primary-air quantities on some exposures to be increased if they are placed on a common zone with other exposures. The primary-air quantity to units serving spaces with less solar exposure can usually be reduced by using separate primary-air zones with different A/T ratios and reheat schedules. Primary-air quantity should never be reduced below minimum ventilation requirements.

The peak cooling load for the south exposure occurs during fall or winter when outdoor temperatures are lower. If shading patterns from adjacent buildings or obstructions are not present, primary-air zoning by solar exposure can reduce air quantities and unit coil sizes on the south. Units can be selected for peak capacity with cold primary air instead of reheated primary air. Primary-air zoning and solar compensators save operating cost on all solar exposures by reducing primary-air reheat and secondary-water refrigeration penalty.

Separate air and water zoning may save operating cost by allowing spaces with less solar exposure to operate on the winter cycle with warm secondary water at outdoor temperatures as high as 16°C during the heating season. Systems with a common secondary-water zone must operate with cold secondary water to cool heavier solar exposures. Primary airflow can be lower because of separate A/T ratios, resulting in reheat and refrigeration cost savings.

Room Control

When room temperature rises, the thermostat must increase the output of the cold secondary coil (in summer) or decrease the output of the warm secondary coil (in winter). Changeover from cold to hot water in the unit coils requires changing the action of the room temperature control system. Room control for nonchangeover systems does not require the changeover action, unless it is required to provide gravity heating during shutdown.

Evaluation

Characteristics of two-pipe in-room terminal unit systems include the following:

- Usually less expensive to install than four-pipe systems
- Less capable of handling widely varying loads or providing a widely varying choice of room temperatures than four-pipe systems
- Present operational and control changeover problems, increasing the need for competent operating personnel
- More costly to operate than four-pipe systems

Electric Heat for Two-Pipe Systems

Electric heat can be supplied with a two-pipe in-room terminal unit system by a central electric boiler and terminal coils, or by individual electric-resistance heating coils in the terminal units. One method uses small electric-resistance terminal heaters for intermediate-season heating and a two-pipe changeover chilled-water/hot-water system. The electric terminal heater heats when outdoor temperatures are above 5°C, so cooling can be kept available with chilled water in the chilled-water/hot-water system. System or zone reheating of primary air is greatly reduced or eliminated entirely. When the outdoor temperature falls below this point, the chilled-water/hot-water system is switched to hot water, providing greater heating capacity. Changeover is limited to a few times per season, and simultaneous heating/cooling capacity is available, except in extremely cold weather, when little, if any, cooling is needed. If electric-resistance terminal heaters are used, they should be prevented from operating whenever the secondary-water system is operated with hot water.

Another method is to size electric resistance terminal heaters for the peak winter heating load and operate the chilled-water system as a nonchangeover cooling-only system. This avoids the operating problem of chilled-water/hot-water system changeover. In fact, this method functions like a four-pipe system, and, in areas where the electric utility establishes a summer demand charge and has a low unit energy cost for high winter consumption, it may have a lower life-cycle cost than hydronic heating with fossil fuel. A variation, especially appropriate for well-insulated office buildings with induction units where cooling is needed in perimeter offices for almost all occupied hours because of internal heat gain, is to use electric heaters in the terminal unit during occupied hours and to provide heating during unoccupied hours by raising primary-air temperature on an outdoor reset schedule.

16. FOUR-PIPE SYSTEMS

Four-pipe systems have a chilled-water supply, chilled-water return, hot-water supply, and hot-water return. The terminal unit usually has two independent secondary-water coils: one served by hot water, the other by cold water. During peak cooling and heating, the four-pipe system performs in a manner similar to the two-pipe system, with essentially the same operating characteristics. Between seasons, any unit can be operated at any level from maximum cooling to maximum heating, if both cold and warm water are being circulated, or between these extremes without regard to other units' operation.

In-room terminal units are selected by their peak capacity. The A/T ratio does not apply to four-pipe systems. There is no need to increase primary-air quantities on units with low solar exposure beyond the amount needed for ventilation and to satisfy cooling loads. The available net cooling is not reduced by heating the primary air. The changeover point is still important, though, because cooling spaces on the sunny side of the building may still require secondary-water cooling to supplement the primary air at low outdoor temperatures.

Zoning

Zoning primary-air or secondary-water systems is not required with four-pipe systems. All terminal units can heat or cool at all times, as long as both hot and cold secondary pumps are operated and sources of heating and cooling are available.

Room Control

The four-pipe terminal usually has two completely separated secondary-water coils: one receiving hot water and the other receiving cold water. The coils are operated in sequence by the same thermostat; they are never operated simultaneously. The unit receives either hot or cold water in varying amounts, or else no flow is present, as shown in Figure 10A. Adjustable, dead-band thermostats further reduce operating cost.

Figure 10B illustrates another unit and control configuration. A single secondary-water coil at the unit and three-way valves located at the inlet and outlet admit water from either the hot- or cold-water supply, as required, and divert it to the appropriate return pipe. This arrangement requires a special three-way modulating valve, originally developed for one form of the three-pipe system. It controls the hot or cold water selectively and proportionally, but does not

mix the streams. The valve at the coil outlet is a two-position valve open to either the hot or cold water return, as required.

Overall, the two-coil arrangement provides a superior four-pipe system. Operation of the induction and fan-coil unit controls is the same year-round.

Evaluation

Compared to the two-pipe system, the four-pipe air-and-water system has the following characteristics:

- More flexible and adaptable to widely differing loads, responding quickly to load changes
- Simpler to operate
- Operates without the summer-winter changeover and primary-air reheat schedule
- Efficiency is greater and operating cost is lower, though initial cost is generally higher
- Can be designed with no interconnection of hot- and cold-water secondary circuits, and the secondary system can be completely independent of the primary-water piping

17. AUTOMATIC CONTROLS AND BUILDING MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS

Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* and Chapter 7 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* discuss automatic controls. The information and concepts discussed there apply to in-room terminal system equipment and systems, as well.

The designer should discuss the complexity, technical expertise, and local resources with the facility's owner/operator before specifying a overly complex or sophisticated control system, because many facilities using in-room terminal units have limited maintenance staff.

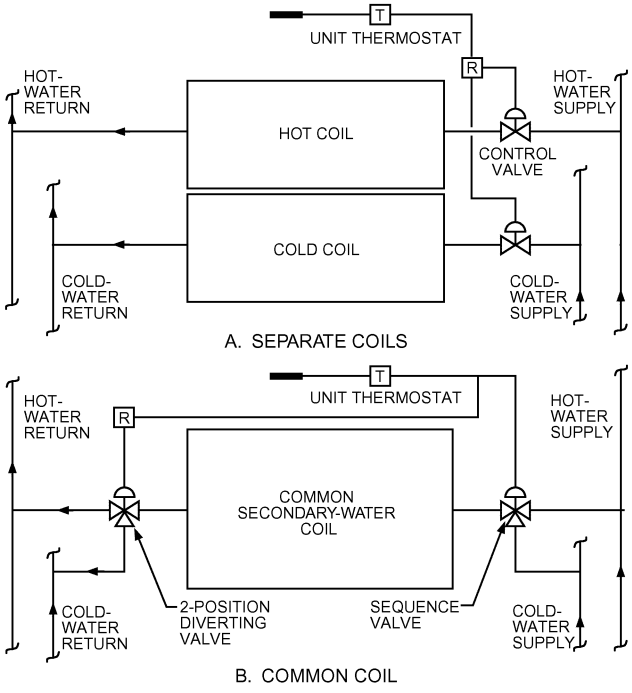


Fig. 10 Fan-Coil Unit Control

18. MAINTENANCE MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS AND BUILDING SYSTEM COMMISSIONING

Chapter 1 discusses both of these topics. In-room terminal systems, like every other system, benefit from consideration and implementation of these practices.

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CHAPTER 6

RADIANT HEATING AND COOLING

PRINCIPLES OF RADIANT SYSTEMS 6.1
Heat Transfer 6.2
Factors Affecting Heat Transfer 6.5
Panel Design 6.7
General Design Considerations 6.9
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RADIANT HEATING AND COOLING SYSTEMS 6.11
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PANEL heating and cooling systems use temperature-controlled indoor surfaces on the floor, walls, or ceiling; temperature is maintained by circulating water, air, or electric current through a circuit embedded in or attached to the panel. A temperature-controlled surface is called a **radiant panel** if 50% or more of the design heat transfer on the temperature-controlled surface takes place by thermal radiation. Panel systems are characterized by controlled surface temperatures below 150°C. Panel systems may be combined either with a central forced-air system of one-zone, constant-temperature, constant-volume design, or with dual-duct, reheat, multizone or variable-volume systems, decentralized convective systems, or in-space fan-coil units. In **decoupled** systems, the air system provides ventilation air and meets dehumidification needs. In **hybrid** (or **load-sharing**) systems, the air system may provide significant additional capacity (e.g., where cooling loads exceed the capabilities of a radiant slab system).

This chapter covers temperature-controlled surfaces that are the primary source of sensible heating and cooling in the conditioned space. For snow-melting and freeze-protection applications, see Chapter 52 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*. Chapter 16 of this volume covers high-temperature panels over 150°C, which may be energized by gas or electricity.

1. PRINCIPLES OF RADIANT SYSTEMS

Thermal radiation (1) is transmitted at the speed of light, (2) travels in straight lines and can be reflected, (3) elevates the temperature of solid objects by absorption but does not noticeably heat the air through which it travels, and (4) is exchanged continuously between all bodies in a building environment. The rate at which thermal radiation occurs depends on the following factors:

- Temperature of the emitting surface and receiver
- Emittance of the radiating surface
- Reflectance, absorptance, and transmittance of the receiver
- View factor between the emitting and receiver surfaces (viewing angle of the occupant to the thermal radiation source)

One example of heating by thermal radiation is the feeling of warmth when standing in the sun's rays on a cool, sunny day. Some of the rays come directly from the sun and include the entire electromagnetic spectrum. Other rays are absorbed by or reflected from surrounding objects. This generates secondary rays that are a combination of the wavelength produced by the temperature of the objects and the wavelength of the reflected rays. If a cloud passes in front of the sun, there is an instant sensation of cold. This sensation is caused by the decrease in the amount of heat received from solar radiation, although there is little, if any, change in the ambient air temperature.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.5, Radiant Heating and Cooling.

In buildings, thermal radiation occurs mostly in the infrared (longwave) region because the temperature of the bodies in a building environment is low. An example is the radiation heat exchange between human bodies and a cold window on an exterior wall. Another major type of radiation is shortwave radiation; the source is mainly the sun, although lighting fixtures also emit energy in the shortwave region. In this chapter, discussions about radiation thermal properties and their effects are limited to the longwave region, unless specifically indicated otherwise.

ASHRAE research project RP-876 (Lindstrom et al. 1998) concluded that surface roughness and texture have insignificant effects on thermal convection and thermal radiation, respectively. Surface longwave emittance (the ratio of the radiant heat flux emitted by a body to that emitted by a blackbody under the same conditions) for typical indoor surfaces, such as carpets, vinyl texture paint, and plastic, remained between 0.9 and 1.0 for panel surface temperatures of 30 to 55°C. For shortwave (solar) absorptance, other factors, such as color and surface roughness, play a significant role.

Thermal comfort, as defined in ASHRAE *Standard* 55-2023, is "that condition of mind that expresses satisfaction with the thermal environment and is assessed by subjective evaluation." Radiant heating and cooling systems can be used to provide unique approaches to dealing with several factors affecting human thermal comfort. Maintaining correct conditions for human thermal comfort by thermal radiation is possible for even the most severe climatic conditions (Buckley 1989).

Panel heating and cooling systems modulate the thermal environment by directly controlling surface temperatures as well as indoor air temperature in an occupied space. With a properly designed system, occupants should not be aware that the environment is being heated or cooled. To provide an acceptable thermal environment to the occupants, the requirements for general and local thermal comfort must be taken into account. Chapter 9 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* and ASHRAE *Standard* 55 have more information on these requirements.

Both the air temperature and the **mean radiant temperature (MRT)** of a space should be taken into account when assessing occupant thermal comfort. The combined influence of these two temperatures is expressed as the **operative temperature**. Mean radiant temperature has a strong influence on human thermal comfort. The magnitude of the effect is slightly greater than that of air temperature at the low air velocities typical to most indoor spaces. When the temperature of surfaces comprising the building (particularly outdoor exposed walls with extensive fenestration) deviates excessively from the air temperature, convective systems sometimes have difficulty counteracting the discomfort caused by cold or hot surfaces. This is because the air temperature used for controlling the HVAC system is significantly different from the MRT, and both affect thermal comfort.

Most building materials have relatively high surface emittance and, therefore, absorb and reradiate heat from active panels. This yields an MRT that is close to the air temperature under most condi-

tions, and thus heating and cooling panels directly lead to a more controlled, acceptable thermal comfort condition in the space.

1.1 HEAT TRANSFER

Sensible heating or cooling panels transfer heat through temperature-controlled (active) surface(s) to or from an indoor space and its enclosure surfaces by thermal radiation and natural convection.

Heat Transfer by Thermal Radiation

The basic equation for a multisurface enclosure with gray, diffuse isothermal surfaces is derived by radiosity formulation methods (see Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). This equation may be written as

$$q_r = J_p - \sum_{j=1}^{n} F_{pj} J_j \tag{1}$$

where

q_r = net heat flux because of thermal radiation on active (heated or cooled) panel surface, W/m^2
J_p = total radiosity leaving or reaching panel surface, W/m^2
J_j = radiosity from or to another surface in room, W/m^2
F_{pj} = radiation angle factor between panel surface and another surface in room (dimensionless)
n = number of surfaces in room other than panel(s)

Equation (1) can be applied to simple and complex enclosures with varying surface temperatures and emittances. The net heat flux by thermal radiation at the panel surfaces can be determined by solving the unknown J_j if the number of surfaces is small. More complex enclosures require computer calculations.

Radiation angle factors can be evaluated using Figure 15 in Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Fanger (1972) shows room-related angle factors; they may also be developed from algorithms in ASHRAE's *Energy Calculations I* (1976).

Several methods have been developed to simplify Equation (1) by reducing a multisurface enclosure to a two-surface approximation. In the **MRT method**, the thermal radiation interchange in an indoor space is modeled by assuming that the surfaces radiate to a fictitious, finite surface that has an emittance and surface temperature that gives about the same heat flux as the real multisurface case (Walton 1980). In addition, angle factors do not need to be determined in evaluating a two-surface enclosure. The MRT equation may be written as

$$q_r = \sigma F_r \left[T_p^4 - T_r^4 \right] \tag{2}$$

where

σ = Stefan-Boltzmann constant = 5.67×10^{-8} W/(m$^2 \cdot$K^4)
F_r = radiation exchange factor (dimensionless)
T_p = effective temperature of heating (cooling) panel surface, K
T_r = temperature of fictitious surface (unheated or uncooled), K

The temperature of the fictitious surface is given by an area emittance weighted average of all surfaces other than the panel(s):

$$T_r = \frac{\sum_{j=p}^{n} A_j \varepsilon_j T_j}{\sum_{j=p}^{n} A_j \varepsilon_j} \tag{3}$$

where

A_j = area of surfaces other than panels, m^2
ε_j = thermal emittance of surfaces other than panel(s) (dimensionless)

When the surface emittances of an enclosure are nearly equal, and surfaces directly exposed to the panel are marginally unheated (uncooled), then Equation (3) becomes the area-weighted average unheated (uncooled) temperature (AUST) of such surfaces exposed to the panels. Therefore, any unheated (uncooled) surface in the same plane with the panel is not accounted for by AUST. For example, if only part of the floor is heated, the remainder of the floor is not included in the calculation of AUST, unless it is observed by other panels in the ceiling or wall.

The radiation interchange factor for two-surface radiation heat exchange is given by the Hottel equation:

$$F_r = \frac{1}{\frac{1}{F_{p-r}} + \left(\frac{1}{\varepsilon_p} - 1\right) + \frac{A_p}{A_r}\left(\frac{1}{\varepsilon_r} - 1\right)} \tag{4}$$

where

F_{p-r} = radiation angle factor from panel to fictitious surface (1.0 for flat panel)
A_p, A_r = area of panel surface and fictitious surface, respectively
ε_p, ε_r = thermal emittance of panel surface and fictitious surface, respectively (dimensionless)

In practice, the thermal emittance ε_p of nonmetallic or painted metal nonreflecting surfaces is about 0.9. When this emittance is used in Equation (4), the radiation exchange factor F_r is about 0.87 for most indoor spaces. Substituting this value in Equation (2), σF_r becomes 4.93×10^{-8}. Min et al. (1956) showed that this constant was 5.03×10^{-8} in their test room. Then the equation for heat flux from thermal radiation for panel heating and cooling becomes approximately

$$q_r = 5 \times 10^{-8}[(t_p + 273.15)^4 - (\text{AUST} + 273.15)^4] \tag{5}$$

where

t_p = effective panel surface temperature, °C
AUST = area-weighted temperature of all indoor surfaces of walls, ceiling, floor, windows, doors, etc. (excluding active panel surfaces), °C

Equation (5) establishes the general sign convention for this chapter, which states that heating by the panel is positive and cooling by the panel is negative.

Radiation exchange calculated from Equation (5) is given in Figure 1. The values apply to ceiling, floor, or wall panel output. Radiation removed by a cooling panel for a range of normally encountered temperatures is given in Figure 2.

In many specific instances where normal multistory commercial construction and fluorescent lighting are used, the indoor air tem-

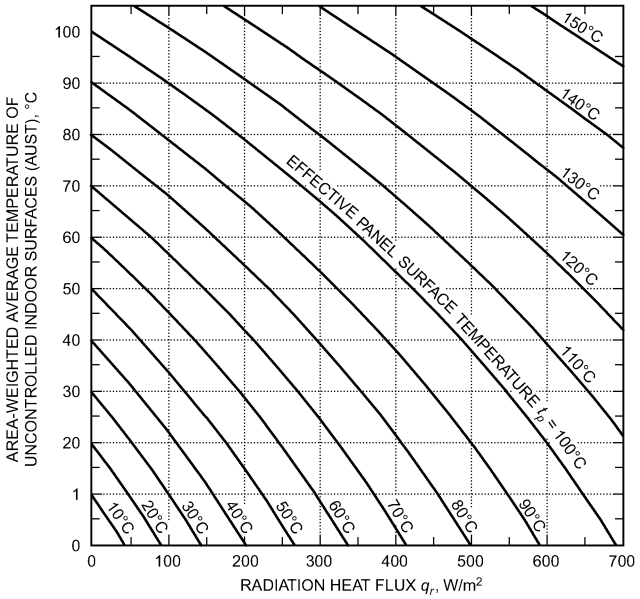


Fig. 1 Radiation Heat Flux at Heated Ceiling, Floor, or Wall Panel Surfaces

perature at the 1.5 m level closely approaches the AUST. In structures where the main heat gain is through the walls or where incandescent lighting is used, wall surface temperatures tend to rise considerably above the indoor air temperature.

Note that Equation (5) is simplified such that it only characterizes longwave radiation heat transfer between the radiant surface and its enclosure surfaces. It does not include the effects of incident solar (shortwave and longwave) radiation and other internal heat gains on the active surfaces. For cases when solar radiation dominates, special considerations must be taken (Feng et al. 2013a; Liu et al. 2015; Simmonds 2006). Dynamic simulation software that implements the heat balance (HB) method (discussed in Chapter 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*) is the most appropriate tool to characterize the performance of radiant surfaces in these cases.

Heat Transfer by Natural Convection

Heat flux from natural convection q_c occurs between the indoor air and the temperature-controlled panel surface. Thermal convection coefficients are not easily established. In natural convection, warming or cooling the boundary layer of air at the panel surface generates air motion. In practice, however, many factors, such as the indoor space configuration, interfere with or affect natural convection. Infiltration/exfiltration, occupants' movement, and mechanical ventilating systems can introduce some forced convection that disturbs the natural convection.

Parmelee and Huebscher (1947) included the effect of forced convection on heat transfer occurring on heating or cooling panel surfaces as an increment to be added to the natural-convection coefficient. However, increased heat transfer from forced convection should not be factored into calculations because the increments are unpredictable in pattern and performance, and forced convection does not significantly increase the total heat flux on the active panel surface.

Natural-convection heat flux in a panel system is a function of the effective panel surface temperature and the temperature of the air layer directly contacting the panel. The most consistent measurements are obtained when the dry-bulb air layer temperature is measured close to the region where the fully developed boundary layer begins, usually 50 to 65 mm from the panel surfaces.

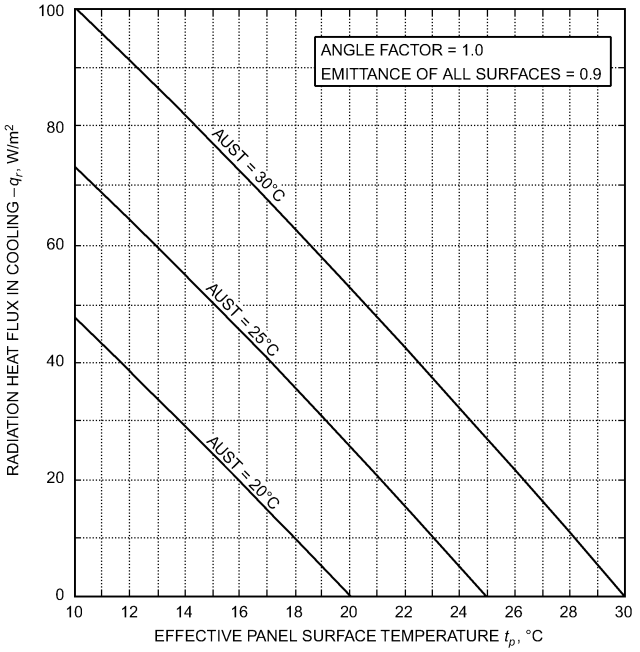


Fig. 2 Heat Removed by Radiation at Cooled Ceiling or Wall Panel Surface

Min et al. (1956) determined natural-convection coefficients 1.5 m above the floor in the center of a 3.66 by 7.47 m room (D_e = 4.91 m). Equations (6) through (11), derived from this research, can be used to calculate heat flux from panels by natural convection.

Natural-convection heat flux between **an all-heated ceiling surface and indoor air**

$$q_c = 0.20\frac{(t_p - t_a)^{1.25}}{D_e^{0.25}} \tag{6}$$

Natural-convection heat flux between **a heated floor or cooled ceiling surface and indoor air**

$$q_c = 2.42\frac{|t_p - t_a|^{0.31}(t_p - t_a)}{D_e^{0.08}} \tag{7}$$

Natural-convection heat flux between **a heated or cooled wall panel surface and indoor air**

$$q_c = 1.87\frac{|t_p - t_a|^{0.32}(t_p - t_a)}{H^{0.05}} \tag{8}$$

where

q_c = heat flux from natural convection, W/m²
t_p = effective temperature of temperature-controlled panel surface, °C
t_a = indoor space dry-bulb air temperature, °C
D_e = equivalent diameter of panel (4 × area/perimeter), m
H = height of wall panel, m

Schutrum and Humphreys (1954) measured panel performance in furnished test rooms that did not have uniform panel surface temperatures and found no variation in performance large enough to be significant in heating practice. Schutrum and Vouris (1954) established that the effect of room size was usually insignificant *except for very large spaces like hangars and warehouses*, for which Equations (6) and (7) should be used. Otherwise, Equations (6), (7), and (8) can be simplified to the following by D_e = 4.91 m and H = 2.7 m:

Natural-convection heat flux between **an all-heated ceiling surface and indoor air**

$$q_c = 0.134(t_p - t_a)^{0.25}(t_p - t_a) \tag{9}$$

Natural-convection heat flux from a heated ceiling may be augmented by leaving cold strips (unheated ceiling sections), which help initiate natural convection. In this case, Equation (9) may be replaced by Equation (10) (Kollmar and Liese 1957):

$$q_c = 0.87(t_p - t_a)^{0.25}(t_p - t_a) \tag{10}$$

For large spaces such as aircraft hangars, if panels are adjoined, Equation (10) should be adjusted with the multiplier $(4.91/D_e)^{0.25}$.

Natural-convection heat flux between **a heated floor or cooled ceiling surface and indoor air**

$$q_c = 2.13|t_p - t_a|^{0.31}(t_p - t_a) \tag{11}$$

Natural-convection heat flux between **a heated or cooled wall panel surface and indoor air**

$$q_c = 1.78|t_p - t_a|^{0.32}(t_p - t_a) \tag{12}$$

There are no confirmed data for floor cooling, but Equation (10) may be used for approximate calculations. Under normal conditions, t_a is the dry-bulb indoor air temperature. In floor-heated or ceiling-

cooled spaces with large proportions of outdoor exposed fenestration, t_a may be taken to equal AUST.

In cooling, t_p is less than t_a, so q_c is negative. Figure 3 shows heat flux by natural convection at floor, wall, and ceiling heating panels as calculated from Equations (11), (12), (9), and (10), respectively.

Figure 4 compares heat removal by natural convection at cooled ceiling panel surfaces, as calculated by Equation (11), with data from Wilkes and Peterson (1938) for specific panel sizes. An additional curve illustrates the effect of forced convection on the latter data. Similar adjustment of the data from Min et al. (1956) is inappropriate, but the effects would be much the same.

Combined Heat Flux (Thermal Radiation and Natural Convection)

The combined heat flux on the active panel surface can be determined by adding the thermal-radiation heat flux q_r as calculated by Equation (5) (or from Figures 1 and 2) to the natural-convection heat flux q_c as calculated from Equations (9), (10), (11), or (12) or from Figure 3 or 4, as appropriate.

Equation (5) requires the AUST for the indoor space. In calculating the AUST, the surface temperature of interior walls may be assumed to be the same as the dry-bulb indoor air temperature. The inside surface temperature t_w of outdoor exposed walls and outdoor exposed floors or ceilings can be calculated from the following relationship:

$$h(t_a - t_u) = U(t_a - t_o) \tag{13}$$

or

$$t_u = t_a - \frac{U}{h}(t_a - t_o) \tag{14}$$

where

h = natural-convection coefficient of the inside surface of an outdoor exposed wall or ceiling
U = overall heat transfer coefficient of wall, ceiling, or floor, W/(m²·K)
t_a = dry-bulb indoor space design air temperature, °C
t_u = inside surface temperature of outdoor exposed wall, °C
t_o = dry-bulb outdoor design air temperature, °C

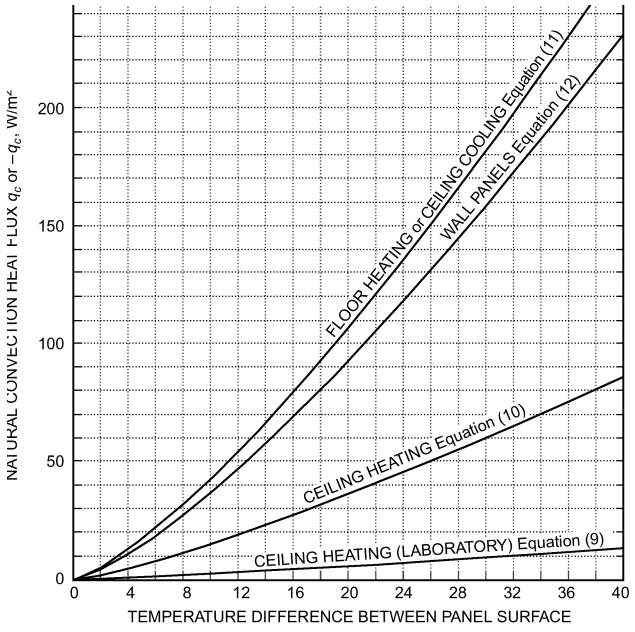


Fig. 3 Natural-Convection Heat Transfer at Floor, Ceiling, and Wall Panel Surfaces

From Table 10 in Chapter 26 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*,

h = 9.26 W/(m²·K) for a horizontal surface with heat flow up
h = 9.09 W/(m²·K) for a vertical surface (wall)
h = 8.29 W/(m²·K) for a horizontal surface with heat flow down

Figure 5 is a plot of Equation (13) for a vertical outdoor wall with 21°C dry-bulb indoor air temperature and h = 9.09 W/(m²·K). For rooms with dry-bulb air temperatures above or below 21°C, the values in Figure 5 can be corrected by the factors plotted in Figure 6.

Tests by Schutrum et al. (1953a, 1953b) and simulations by Kalisperis (1985) based on a program developed by Kalisperis and Summers (1985) show that the AUST and indoor air temperature are almost equal, if there is little or no outdoor exposure. Steinman et al. (1989) noted that this may not apply to enclosures with large fenestration or a high percentage of outdoor exposed wall and/or ceiling surface area. These surfaces may have a lower (in heating) or higher (in cooling) AUST, which increases the heat flux from thermal radiation.

Figure 7 shows the combined heat flux from thermal radiation and natural convection for cooling, as given in Figures 2 and 4. The data in Figure 7 do not include solar, lighting, occupant, or equipment heat gains.

In suspended-ceiling panels, heat is transferred from the back of the ceiling panel to the floor slab above (in heating) or vice versa (in cooling). The ceiling panel surface temperature is affected because of heat transfer to or from the panel and the slab by thermal radiation and, to a much smaller extent, by natural convection. The thermal-

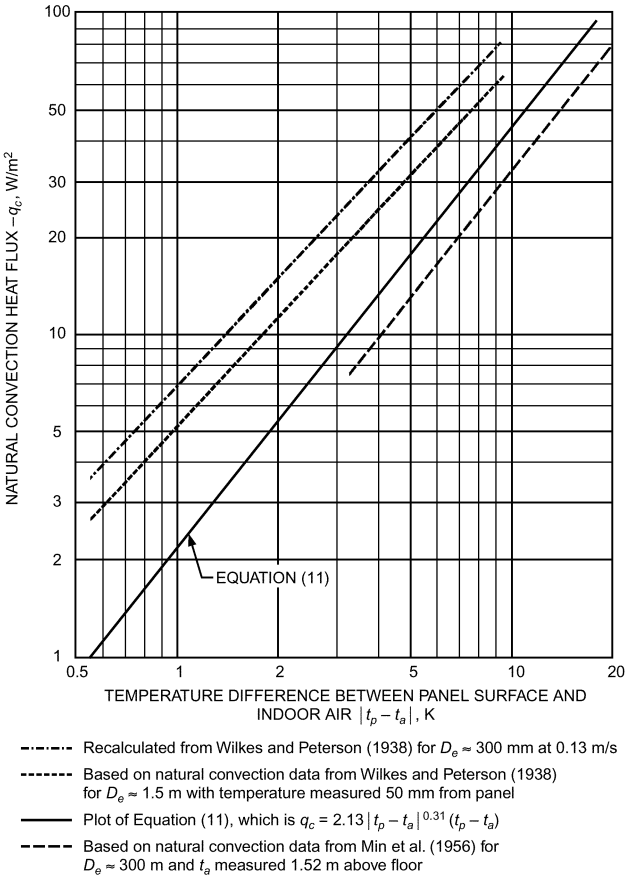


Fig. 4 Empirical Data for Heat Removal by Ceiling Cooling Panels from Natural Convection

radiation component of the combined heat flux can be approximated using Equation (5) or Figure 1. The natural-convection component can be estimated from Equation (10) or (11) or from Figure 3 or 4. In this case, the temperature difference is that between the top of the ceiling panel and the midspace of the ceiling. The temperature of the ceiling space should be determined by testing, because it varies with different panel systems. However, much of this heat transfer is nullified when insulation is placed over the ceiling panel, which, for perforated metal panels, also provides acoustical absorption.

If artificial lighting fixtures are recessed into the suspended ceiling space, radiation from the top of the fixtures raises the overhead slab temperature and heat is transferred to the indoor air by natural convection. This heat is absorbed at the top of the cooled ceiling panels both by thermal radiation, in accordance with Equation (5) or Figure 2, and by thermal convection, generally in accordance with Equation (10). The amount the top of the panel absorbs depends on the system. Similarly, panels installed under a roof absorb additional heat, depending on configuration and insulation.

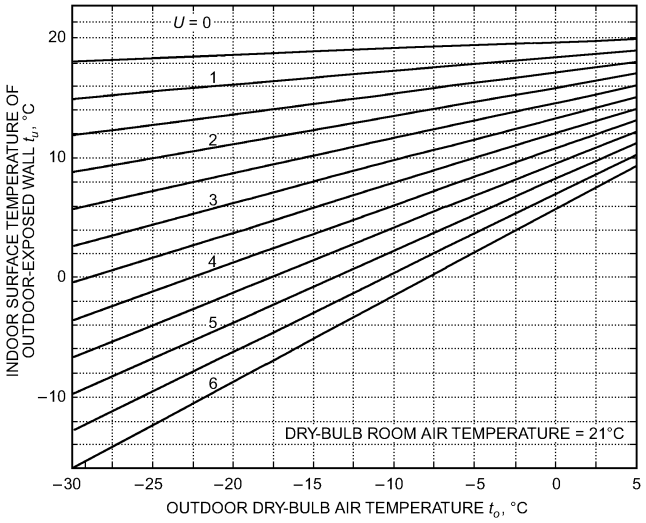


Fig. 5 Relation of Inside Surface Temperature to Overall Heat Transfer Coefficient

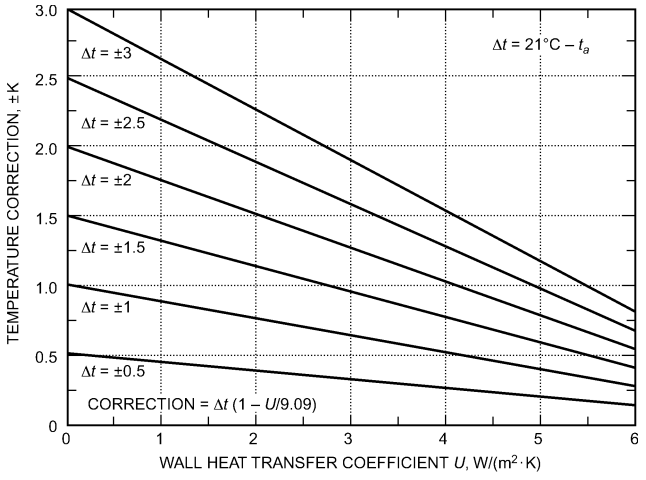


Fig. 6 Inside Surface Temperature Correction for Exposed Wall at Dry-Bulb Air Temperatures Other Than 21°C

1.2 FACTORS AFFECTING HEAT TRANSFER

Panel Thermal Resistance

Any thermal resistance between the indoor space and the active panel surface, as well as between the active panel surface and the hydronic tubing or electric circuitry in the panel, reduces system performance. Thermal resistance to heat transfer may vary considerably among different panels, depending on the type of bond between the tubing (electric cabling) and the panel material. Factors such as corrosion or adhesion defects between lightly touching surfaces and the method of maintaining contact may change the bond with time. The actual thermal resistance of any proposed system should be verified by testing. Specific resistance and performance data, when available, should be obtained from the manufacturer based on performance tests such as those described in ANSI/ASHRAE *Standard* 138 or European (CEN) *Standard* EN 14240. Panel thermal resistances include

r_t = thermal resistance of tube wall per unit tube spacing in a hydronic system, (m·K)/W

r_s = thermal resistance between tube (electric cable) and panel body per unit spacing between adjacent tubes (electric cables), (m·K)/W

r_p = thermal resistance of panel body, (m²·K)/W

r_c = thermal resistance of active panel surface covers, (m²·K)/W

r_u = characteristic (combined) panel thermal resistance, (m²·K)/W

For a given adjacent tube (electric cable) spacing M,

$$r_u = r_t M + r_s M + r_p + r_c \tag{15}$$

When the tubes (electric cables) are embedded in the slab, r_s may be neglected. However, if they are externally attached to the body of the panel, r_s may be significant, depending on the quality of bonding. Table 1 gives typical r_s values for various ceiling panels.

The value of r_p may be calculated if the characteristic panel thickness x_p and the thermal conductivity k_p of the panel material are known.

If the tubes (electric cables) are embedded in the panel,

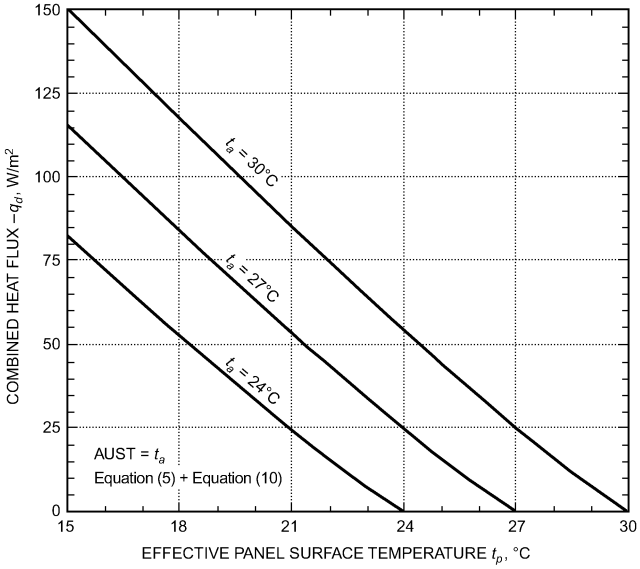
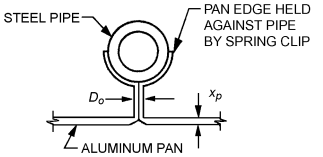
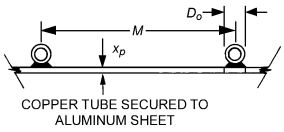
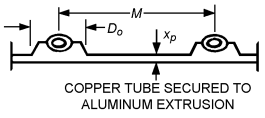
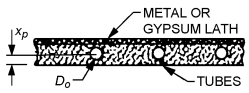
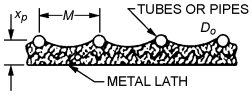


Fig. 7 Cooled Ceiling Panel Performance in Uniform Environment with No Infiltration and No Internal Heat Sources

Table 1 Thermal Resistance of Ceiling Panels

Type of Panel	Thermal Resistance r_p, $(m^2 \cdot K)/W$	Thermal Resistance r_s, $(m \cdot K)/W$
	$\frac{x_p}{k_p}$	0.32
	$\frac{x_p}{k_p}$	0.38
	$\frac{x_p}{k_p}$	0.10
	$\frac{x_p - D_o/2}{k_p}$	≈ 0
	$\frac{x_p - D_o/2}{k_p}$	≤0.12

$$r_p = \frac{x_p - D_o/2}{k_p} \tag{16}$$

where D_o = outside diameter of the tube (electric cable). Hydronic floor heating by a heated slab and gypsum-plaster ceiling heating are typical examples.

If the tubes (electric cable) are attached to the panel,

$$r_p = \frac{x_p}{k_p} \tag{17}$$

Metal ceiling panels (see Table 1) and tubes under subfloor (see Figure 23) are typical examples.

Thermal resistance per unit on-center spacing (M = unity) of circular tubes with inside diameter D_i and thermal conductivity k_t is

$$r_t = \frac{\ln(D_o/D_i)}{2\pi k_t} \tag{18}$$

For an elliptical tube with semimajor and semiminor axes of a and b, respectively, measured at both the outside and inside of the tube,

$$k_t = \ln\frac{(a_o + b_o)/(a_i + b_i)}{2\pi k_t} \tag{19}$$

In an electric cable, $r_t = 0$.

In metal pipes, r_t is virtually the fluid-side thermal resistance:

$$r_t = \frac{1}{hD_i} \tag{20}$$

If the tube has multiple layers, Equations (18) or (19) should be applied to each individual layer and then summed to calculate the tube's total thermal resistance. Thermal resistance of capillary tube mats can also be calculated from either Equation (18) or (19).

Table 2 Thermal Conductivity of Typical Tube Material

Material	Thermal Conductivity k_t, W/(m · K)
Carbon steel (AISI 1020)	52
Aluminum	237
Copper (drawn)	390
Red brass (85 Cu-15 Zn)	159
Stainless steel (AISI 202)	17
Low-density polyethylene (LDPE)	0.31
High-density polyethylene (HDPE)	0.42
Cross-linked polyethylene (VPE or PEX)	0.38
Textile-reinforced rubber hose (HTRH)	0.29
Polypropylene block copolymer (PP-C)	0.23
Polypropylene random copolymer (PP-RC)	0.24

Typically, capillary tubes are circular, 2 mm in internal diameter, and 12 mm apart.

Capillary tube mats can be easily applied to existing ceilings in a sand plaster cover layer.

If the tube material is nonmetallic, oxygen ingress may be a problem, especially in panel heating. To avoid oxygen corrosion in the heating system, either (1) tubing with an oxygen barrier layer, (2) corrosion-inhibiting additives in the hydronic system, or (3) a heat exchanger separating the panel circuit from the rest of the system should be used.

Table 8 in Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* may be used to calculate the forced-convection heat transfer coefficient h. Table 2 in this chapter gives values of k_t for different tube and pipe materials.

Effect of Floor Coverings

Active panel surface coverings like carpets and pads on the floor can have a pronounced effect on a panel system's performance. The added thermal resistance r_c reduces the panel surface heat flux. To reestablish the required performance, the water temperature must be increased (decreased in cooling). Thermal resistance of a panel covering is

$$r_c = \frac{x_c}{k_c} \tag{21}$$

where

r_c = thermal resistance of panel covering, $(m^2 \cdot K)/W$
x_c = thickness of each panel covering, m
k_c = thermal conductivity of each panel cover, W/(m · K)

If the active panel surface has more than one cover, individual r_c values should be added. Table 3 gives typical r_c values for floor coverings.

If there are covered and bare floor panels in the same hydronic system, it may be possible to maintain a sufficiently high water temperature to satisfy the covered panels and balance the system by throttling the flow to the bare slabs. In some instances, however, the increased water temperature required when carpeting is applied over floor panels makes it impossible to balance floor panel systems in which only some rooms have carpeting unless the piping is arranged to permit zoning using more than one water temperature.

Panel Heat Losses or Gains

Heat transferred from the upper surface of ceiling panels, the back surface of wall panels, the underside of floor panels, or the exposed perimeter of any panel is considered a panel heat loss (gain in cooling). Panel heat losses (gains) are part of the building heat loss (gain) if the heat transfer is between the panel and the outside of the building. If heat transfer is between the panel and another conditioned space, the panel heat loss (gain) is a positive

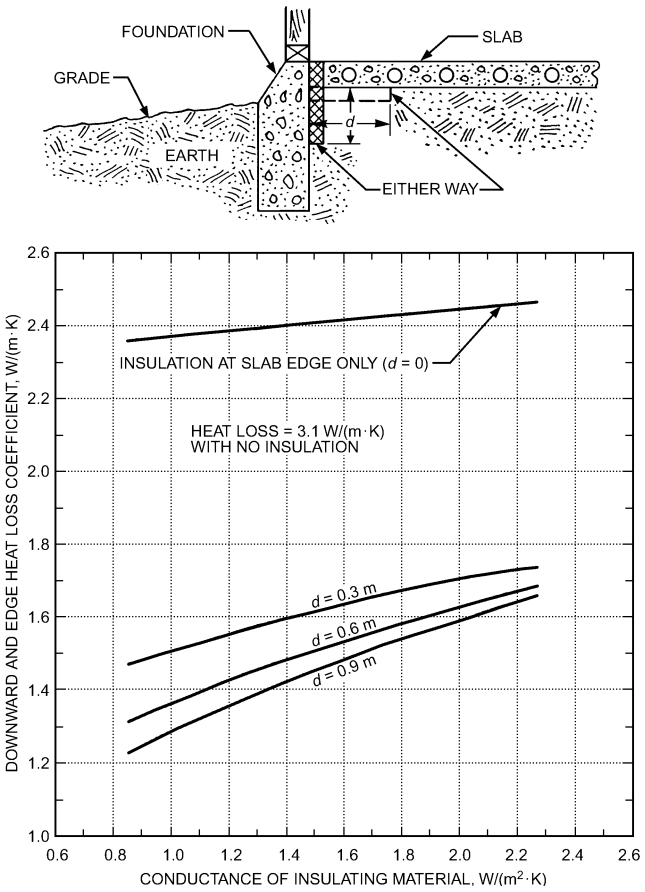


Fig. 8 Downward and Edgewise Heat Loss Coefficient for Concrete Floor Slabs on Grade

conditioning contribution for that space instead. In either case, the magnitude of panel loss (gain) should be calculated.

Panel heat loss (gain) to (from) space outside the conditioned space should be kept to a reasonable amount by insulation. For example, a floor panel may overheat the basement below, and a ceiling panel may cause the temperature of a floor surface above it to be too high for comfort unless it is properly insulated.

The heat loss from most panels can be calculated by using the coefficients given in Table 1 in Chapter 26 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. These coefficients should not be used to determine downward heat loss from panels built on grade because heat flow from them is not uniform (ASHAE 1956, 1957; Sartain and Harris 1956). The heat loss from panels built on grade can be estimated from Figure 8 or from Equations (40) and (41) in Chapter 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Panel Performance

As with other electric or hydronic terminal units, panel performance can be described by the following equation:

$$q = C\Delta T|\Delta T|^{m-1} \tag{22}$$

where

q = combined heat flux on panel surface, W/m²
C = characteristic performance coefficient, W/(m² ·K^m)
ΔT = temperature difference, either $t_p - t_o$ in electric heating or $t_w - t_o$ in hydronic heating, K
t_o = operative temperature, °C
m = $2 + r_c/2r_p$

Table 3 Thermal Resistance of Floor Coverings

Description	Thermal Resistance r_c, (m² · K)/W
Bare concrete, no covering	0
Asphalt tile	0.009
Rubber tile	0.009
Light carpet	0.106
Light carpet with rubber pad	0.176
Light carpet with light pad	0.247
Light carpet with heavy pad	0.300
Heavy carpet	0.141
Heavy carpet with rubber pad	0.211
Heavy carpet with light pad	0.281
Heavy carpet with heavy pad	0.335
10 mm hardwood	0.095
16 mm wood floor (oak)	0.100
13 mm oak parquet and pad	0.120
Linoleum	0.021
Marble floor and mudset	0.031
Rubber pad	0.109
Prime urethane underlayment, 10 mm	0.284
1.5 kg/m³ waffled sponge rubber	0.137
Bonded urethane, 13 mm	0.368

Notes:
1. Carpet pad thickness should not be more than 6 mm
2. Total thermal resistance of carpet is more a function of thickness than of fiber type.
3. Generally, thermal resistance (R-value) is approximately 0.018 times the total carpet thickness in millimetres.
4. Before carpet is installed, verify that the backing is resistant to long periods of continuous heat up to 50°C

C and m for a particular panel may be either experimentally determined or calculated from the design material given in this chapter. In either case, sufficient data or calculation points must be gathered to cover the entire operational design range (ASHRAE *Standard* 138).

Radiant panel product performance data can be obtained from the manufacturers. ASHRAE *Standard* 138 and European *Standards* EN 14240 and EN 14037 regulate the testing and rating method for radiant panel cooling and heating performance. European *Standard* EN 1264 regulates the testing methods for the embedded radiant heating and cooling systems.

1.3 PANEL DESIGN

Either hydronic or electric circuits control the active panel surface temperature. The required effective surface temperature t_p necessary to maintain a combined heat flux q (where $q = q_r + q_c$) at steady-state design conditions can be calculated by using applicable heat flux equations for q_r and q_c, depending on the position of the panel. At a given t_a, AUST must be predicted first. Figures 9 and 10 can also be used to find t_p when q and AUST are known. The next step is to determine the required average water (brine) temperature t_w in a hydronic system. It depends primarily on t_p, tube spacing M, and the characteristic panel thermal resistance r_u. Figure 9 provides design information for heating and cooling panels, positioned either at the ceiling or on the floor.

The combined heat flux for ceiling and floor panels can be read directly from Figure 9. Here q_u is the combined heat flux on the floor panel and q_d is the combined heat flux on the ceiling panel. For an electric heating system, t_w scales correspond to the skin temperature of the cable. The following algorithm (TSI 1994) may also be used to design and analyze panels under steady-state conditions:

$$t_d \approx t_a + \frac{(t_p - t_a)M}{2W\eta + D_o} + q(r_p + r_c + r_s M) \tag{23}$$

where

t_d = average skin temperature of tubing (electric cable), °C
q = combined heat flux on panel surface, W/m^2
t_a = dry-bulb indoor air design temperature, °C. In floor-heated or ceiling-cooled indoor spaces that have large fenestration, t_a may be replaced with AUST.
D_o = outside diameter of embedded tube or characteristic contact width of attached heating or cooling element with panel (see Table 1), m
M = on-center spacing of adjacent tubes (electric cables), m
$2W$ = net spacing between tubing (electric cables), $M - D_o$, m
η = fin efficiency, dimensionless

The first two terms in Equation (23) give the maximum (minimum in cooling) value of the panel surface temperature profile; consequently, if tube spacing M is too large, hot strips along the panel surface may occur in heating, or local condensation occur on these cold strips in sensible cooling mode.

$$\eta = \frac{\tanh(fW)}{fW} \tag{24}$$

$$\eta \approx 1/fW \qquad \text{for} \quad fW > 2 \tag{25}$$

The following equation, which includes transverse heat diffusion in the panel and surface covers, may be used to calculate the fin coefficient f:

$$f \approx \left[\frac{q}{m(t_p - t_a)\sum_{i=1}^{n} k_i x_i} \right]^{1/2} \qquad \text{for } t_p \neq t_a \tag{26}$$

where

f = fin coefficient
m = $2 + r_c/2r_p$
n = total number of different material layers, including panel and surface covers
x_i = characteristic thickness of each material layer i, m
k_i = thermal conductivity of each layer i, W/(m·K)

For a hydronic system, the required average water (brine) temperature is

$$t_w = (q + q_b)Mr_t + t_d \tag{27}$$

where q_b is the flux of back and perimeter heat losses (positive) in a heated panel or gains (negative) in a cooling panel.

This algorithm may be applied to outdoor slab heating systems, provided that the combined heat flux q is calculated according to Chapter 52 in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, with the following conditions: no snow, no evaporation, q (in panel heating) = q_h (radiation and convection heat flux in snow-melting calculations). With a careful approach, outdoor slab cooling systems may be analyzed by incorporating the solar radiation gain, thermal radiation, and forced convection from the sky and ambient air.

ISO *Standard* 18566-2014 provides an in-depth description of the design, installation, and control of radiant panels.

Special Cases

Figure 9 may also be used for panels with tubing not embedded in the panel:

- $x_p = 0$ if tubes are externally attached.

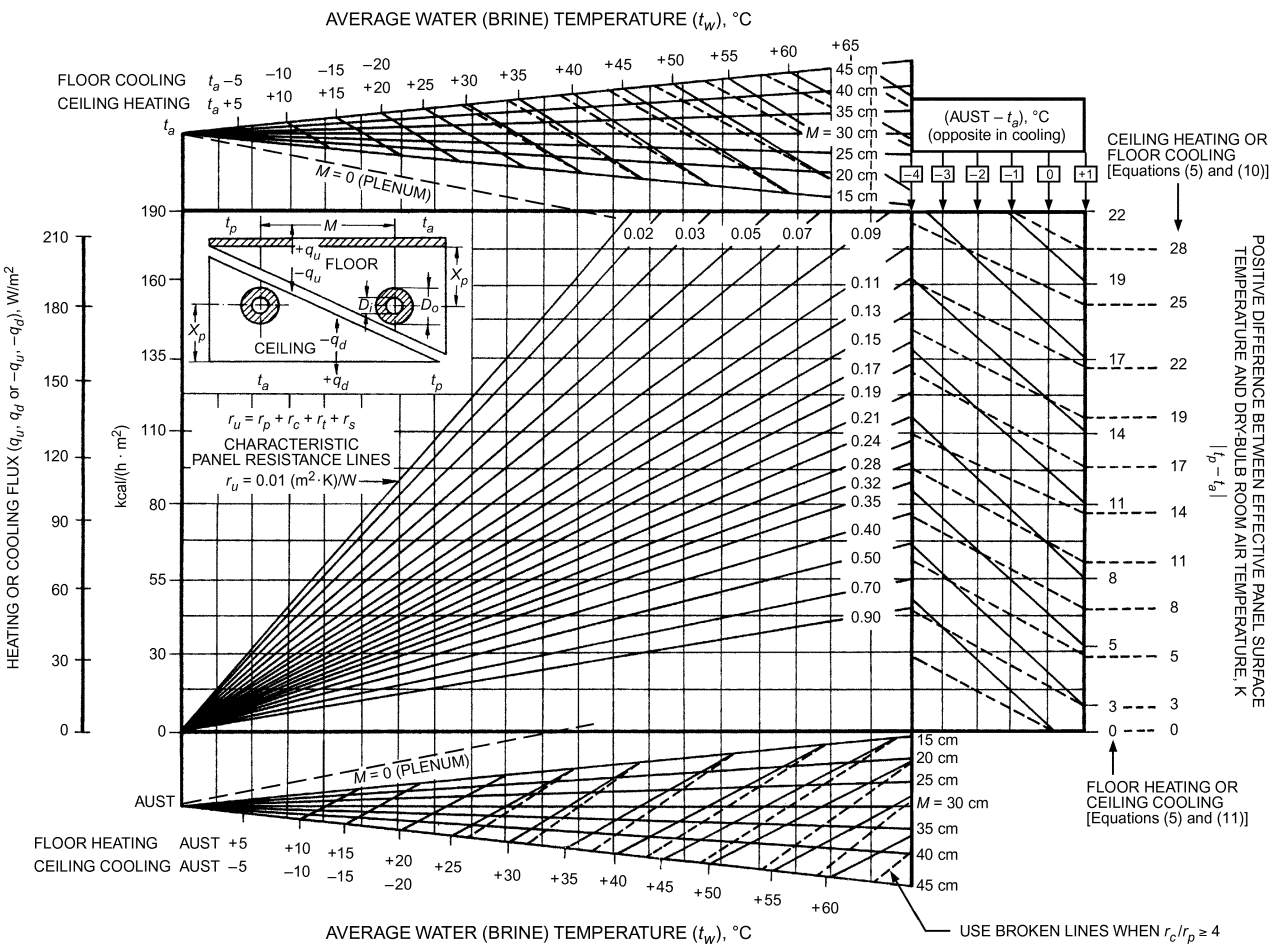


Fig. 9 Design Graph for Sensible Heating and Cooling with Floor and Ceiling Panels

- In spring-clipped external tubing, $D_i = 0$ and D_o is the clip thickness.

Warm air and electric heating elements are two design concepts influenced by local factors. The warm-air system has a special cavity construction where air is supplied to a cavity behind or under the panel surface. The air leaves the cavity through a normal diffuser arrangement and is supplied to the indoor space. Generally, these systems are used as floor panels in schools and in floors subject to extreme cold, such as in an overhang. Cold outdoor temperatures and heating medium temperatures must be analyzed with regard to potential damage to the building construction. Electric heating elements embedded in the floor or ceiling construction and unitized electric ceiling panels are used in various applications to provide both full heating and spot heating of the space.

Examples

Residential heating applications usually consist of tubes or electric elements embedded in masonry floors or plaster ceilings. This construction is suitable where loads are stable and building design minimizes solar effects. However, in buildings where fenestration is large and thermal loads change abruptly, the slow response, thermal lag, and override effect of masonry panels are unsatisfactory. Metal ceiling panels with low thermal mass respond quickly to load changes (Berglund et al. 1982).

Panels are preferably located in the ceiling because it is exposed to all other indoor surfaces, occupants, and objects in the conditioned indoor space. It is not likely to be covered, as floors are, and higher surface temperatures can be maintained. Figure 10 gives design data for ceiling and wall panels with effective surface temperatures up to 140°C.

Example 1. An in-slab, on-grade panel (see Figure 20) will be used for both heating and cooling. $M = 300$ mm, $r_u = 0.09$ (m²·K)/W, and r_c/r_p is less than 4. t_a is 20°C in winter and 4.5°C in summer.

AUST is expected to be 1 K less than t_a in winter heating and 0.5 K higher than t_a in summer cooling.

What is the average water temperature and effective floor temperature (1) for winter heating when $q_u = 130$ W/m², and (2) for summer cooling when $-q_u = 50$ W/m²?

Solution:

Winter heating

To obtain the average water temperature using Figure 9, start on the left axis where $q_u = 130$ W/m². Proceed right to the intersect $r_u = 0.09$ and then down to the $M = 300$ mm line. The reading is AUST + 31, which is the solid line value because $r_c/r_p < 4$. As stated in the initial problem, AUST = $t_a - 1$ or AUST = 20 – 1 = 19°C. Therefore, the average water temperature would be $t_w = 31 + 19 = 50$°C.

To find the effective floor temperature, start at $q_u = 130$ W/m² in Figure 9 and proceed right to AUST = $t_a - 1$ K. The solid line establishes 12 K as the temperature difference between the panel and the indoor air. Therefore, the effective floor temperature $t_p = t_a + 12$ or $t_p = 20 + 12 = 32$°C.

Summer cooling

Using Figure 9, start at the left axis at $-q_u = 50$ W/m². Proceed to $r_u = 0.09$, and then up (for cooling) to $M = 300$ mm, which reads $t_a - 11$ or 24.5 – 11 = 13.5°C average water temperature for cooling.

To obtain the effective floor temperature at $-q_u = 50$ W/m², proceed to AUST – t_a = +0.5 K, which reads –5°C. Therefore, the effective floor temperature is 24.5 – 5 = 19.5°C.

Example 2. An aluminum extrusion panel, which is 0.127 mm thick with heat element spacing of $M = 150$ mm, is used in the ceiling for heating. If a ceiling heat flux q_d of 1260 W/m² is required to maintain room temperature t_a at 20°C, what is the required heating element skin temperature t_d and effective panel surface temperature t_p?

Solution:

Using Figure 10 enter the left axis heat flux q_d at 1260 W/m². Proceed to the line corresponding to $t_a = 20$°C and then move up to the $M = 150$ mm line. The ceiling heating element temperature t_d at the intersection point is 160°C. From the bottom axis of Figure 10, the effective panel surface temperature t_p is 129°C.

2. GENERAL DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

Principal **advantages** of panel systems are the following:

- Because not only indoor air temperature but also mean radiant temperature can be controlled, total human thermal comfort may be better satisfied.
- Because the operative temperature for required human thermal comfort may be maintained by primarily controlling the mean radiant temperature of the conditioned indoor space, dry-bulb air temperature may be lower (in heating) or higher (in cooling), which reduces sensible heating or cooling loads (see Chapter 16 for the definition and calculation of operative and mean radiant temperatures).
- Hydronic panel systems may be connected in series, following other hydronic heating or cooling systems (i.e., their return water may be used), increasing exergetic efficiency.
- Comfort levels can be better than those of other space-conditioning systems because thermal loads are satisfied directly and air motion in the space corresponds to required ventilation only.
- Waste and low-enthalpy energy sources and heat pumps may be directly coupled to panel systems without penalty on equipment sizing and operation. Being able to select from a wide range of moderate operation temperatures ensures optimum design for minimum cost and maximum thermal and exergetic efficiency.
- Seasonal thermal distribution efficiency in buildings may be higher than in other hydronic systems.
- In terms of simple payback period, ceiling cooling panels and chilled beams have the highest technical energy savings potential (DOE 2002).
- Part or all of the building structure may be thermally activated (Meierhans and Olesen 2002).
- Space-conditioning equipment is not required at outdoor exposed walls, simplifying wall, floor, and structural systems.
- Almost all mechanical equipment may be centrally located, simplifying maintenance and operation.
- No space within the conditioned space is required for mechanical equipment. This feature is especially valuable in hospital patient rooms, offices, and other applications where space is at a premium, if maximum cleanliness is essential or legally required.
- Significantly reduced need for ductwork allows either lower floor-to-floor heights (reducing façade costs and overall building height) or higher ceilings (an architecturally desirable feature).
- Draperies and curtains can be installed at outdoor exposed walls without interfering with the space-conditioning system.
- When four-pipe systems are used, cooling and heating can be simultaneous, without central zoning or seasonal changeover.
- Supply air requirements usually do not exceed those required for ventilation and humidity control.
- Modular panels provide flexibility to meet changes in partitioning.
- A 100% outdoor air system may be installed with smaller penalties in refrigeration load because of reduced air quantities.
- A common central air system can serve both the interior and perimeter zones.
- Wet-surface cooling coils are eliminated from the occupied space, reducing the potential for septic contamination.
- Modular panel systems can use the automatic sprinkler system piping (see NFPA *Standard* 13). The maximum water temperature must not fuse the heads.
- Panel heating and cooling with minimum supply air quantities provide a draft-free environment.
- Noise associated with fan-coil or induction units is eliminated.

- Peak loads are reduced as a result of thermal energy storage in the panel structure, as well as walls and partitions directly exposed to panels.
- Panels can be combined with other space-conditioning systems to decouple several indoor requirements (e.g., humidity control, indoor air quality, air velocity) and optimally satisfy them without compromises.
- In-floor heating creates inhospitable living conditions for house dust mites compared to other heating systems (Sugawara et al. 1996).

Disadvantages include the following:

- Response time can be slow if controls and/or heating elements are not selected or installed correctly.
- Improper selection of panel heating or cooling tube or electrical heating element spacing and/or incorrect sizing of heating/cooling source can cause nonuniform surface temperatures or insufficient sensible heating or cooling capacity.
- Radiant systems can satisfy only *sensible* heating and cooling loads. In a stand-alone radiant cooling system, dehumidification and surface condensation may be of prime concern and a secondary air-handling system must provide ventilation air and handle latent loads.
- Radiant systems in which the tubing is embedded in a building surface or in the structural slab typically have a large exposed concrete surface area. Additional acoustical treatments are often required to reduce room reverberation time to a more desirable level.

2.1 HYBRID SYSTEMS

In general, any HVAC system relies on a single heat transfer mode as its major heat transfer mechanism. For example, central air

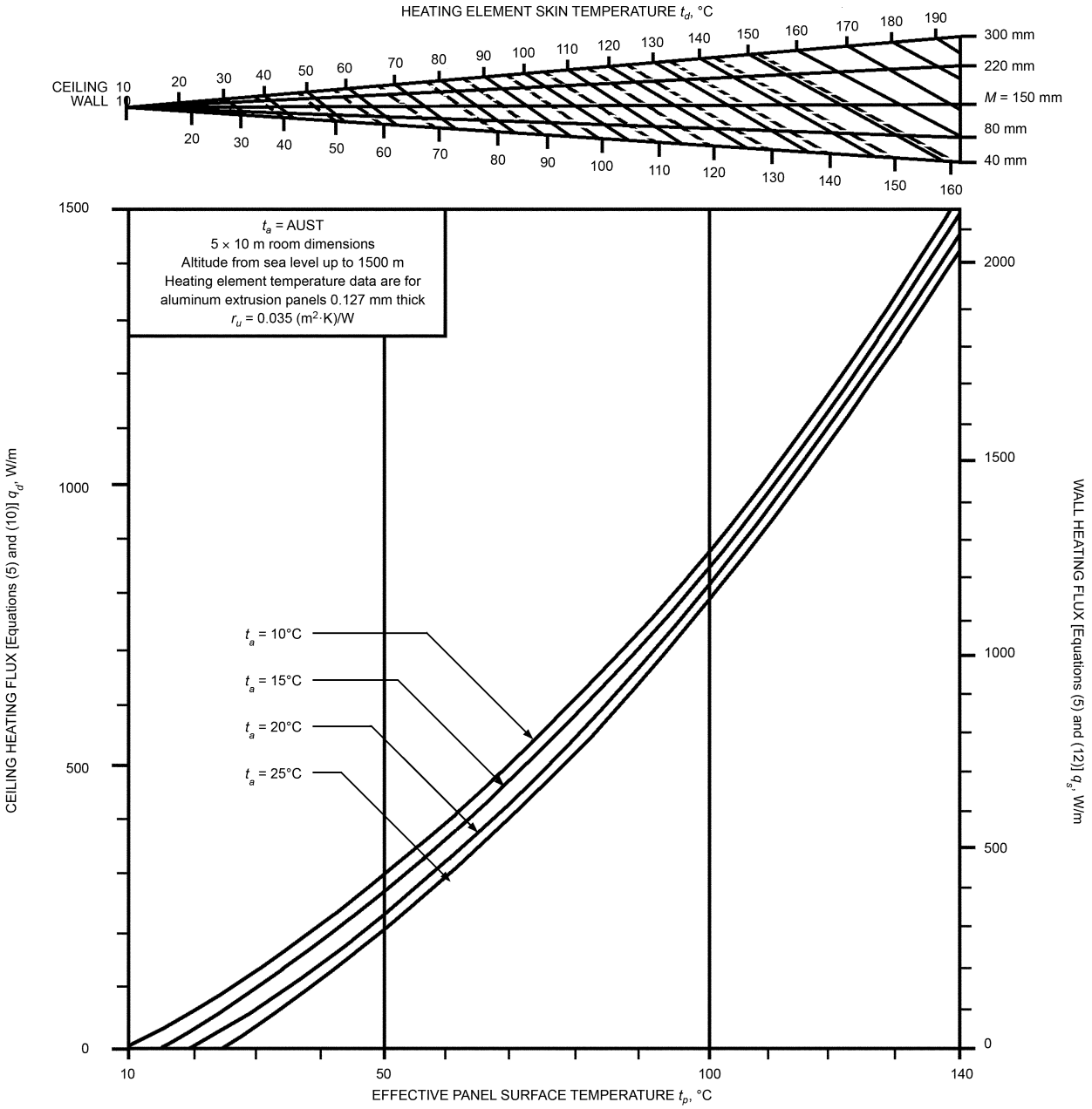


Fig. 10 Design Graph for Heating with Aluminum Ceiling and Wall Panels

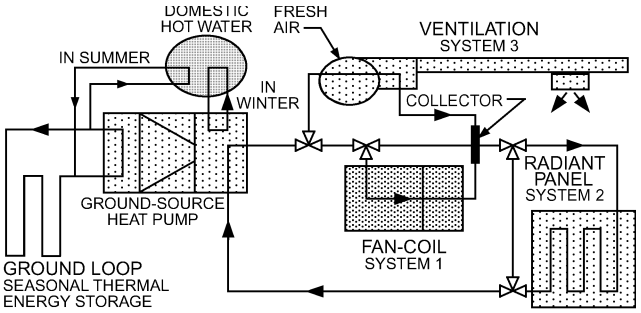


Fig. 11 Typical Residential Hybrid HVAC System

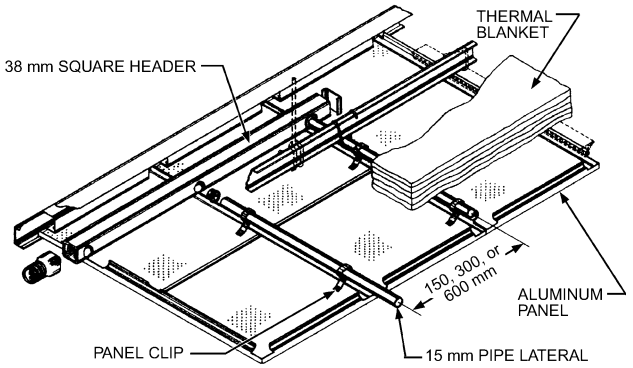


Fig. 12 Metal Ceiling Panels Attached to Pipe Laterals

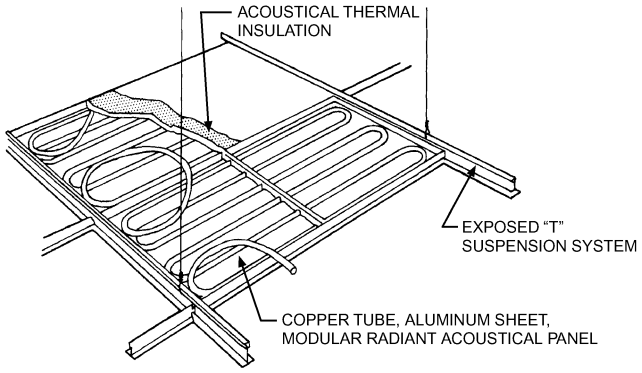


Fig. 13 Metal Ceiling Panels Bonded to Copper Tubing

conditioning is a forced-convection system, and a high-intensity radiant system operates almost purely with thermal radiation. Additionally, every system has a typical range for satisfactory and economical operation, with its own advantages, limitations, and disadvantages. A single system may not be sufficient to encompass all requirements of a given building in the most efficient and economical way. Under these circumstances, it may be more desirable to decouple several components of indoor space conditioning, and satisfy them by several dedicated systems. A hybrid heating and cooling system is an optimum partnership of multiple, collocated, simultaneously operating heating and cooling systems, each of which is based on one of the primary heat transfer modes (i.e., radiation and convection). In its most practical form, hybrid heating and cooling may consist of a radiant system and a forced-air system. The forced-air component may be a central HVAC system or a hydronic system such as fan-coils, as shown in Figure 11. Here, a panel system is added downstream of the condensing fan-coils, and ventilation is provided by a separate system with substantially reduced duct size. Dehumidification and ventilation problems that may be associated with stand-alone panel cooling systems may be eliminated by hybrid HVAC systems.

ASHRAE research project RP-1140 (Scheatzle 2003) successfully demonstrated the use of panel systems for both heating and cooling, in conjunction with a forced-convection system, to economically achieve year-round thermal comfort in a residence using both active and passive performance of the building and a ground-source heat pump. Skylighting, an energy recovery ventilator, and packaged dehumidifiers were also used. Twenty-four-month-long tests indicated that a radiant/convective system can offer substantial cost savings, given proper design and control.

3. RADIANT HEATING AND COOLING SYSTEMS

The following are the most common forms of panels applied in radiant heating and cooling systems:

- Hydronic ceiling panels
- Embedded tubing in ceilings, walls, or floors
- Electric ceiling panels for heating only
- Electrically heated ceilings or floors

3.1 HYDRONIC CEILING PANELS

Metal ceiling panels can be integrated into a system that heats and cools. In such a system, a source of dehumidified ventilation air is required in summer, so the system is classed as an air-and-water system. Also, various amounts of forced air are supplied year-round. When metal panels are applied for heating only, a ventilation system may be required, depending on local codes.

Ceiling panel systems are an outgrowth of perforated metal, suspended acoustical ceilings. These ceiling panel systems are usually designed into buildings where the suspended acoustical ceiling can be combined with panel heating and cooling. The panels can be designed as small units to fit the building module, which provides extensive flexibility for zoning and control, or the panels can be arranged as large continuous areas for maximum economy. Some ceiling installations require active panels to cover only part of the indoor space and compatible matching acoustical panels for the remaining ceiling area.

Three types of metal ceiling systems are available. The first consists of light aluminum panels, usually 300 by 600 mm, attached in the field to 15 mm galvanized pipe coils. Figure 12 shows a metal ceiling panel system that uses 15 mm pipe laterals on 150, 300, or 600 mm centers, hydraulically connected in a sinuous or parallel-flow welded system. Aluminum ceiling panels are clipped to these pipe laterals and act as a heating panel when warm water is flowing or as a cooling panel when chilled water is flowing.

The second type of panel consists of a copper coil secured to the aluminum face sheet to form a modular panel. Modular panels are available in sizes up to about 910 by 1520 mm and are held in position by various types of ceiling suspension systems, most typically a standard suspended T-bar 600 by 1200 mm exposed grid system. Figure 13 shows metal panels using a copper tube pressed into an aluminum extrusion, although other methods of securing the copper tube have proven equally effective.

Metal ceiling panels can be perforated so that the ceiling becomes sound absorbent when acoustical material is installed on the back of the panels. The acoustical blanket is also required for thermal reasons, so that reverse loss or upward flow of heat from the metal ceiling panels is minimized.

The third type of panel is an aluminum extrusion face sheet with a copper tube mechanically fastened into a channel housing on the back. Extruded panels can be manufactured in almost any shape and size. Extruded aluminum panels are often used as long, narrow panels at the outside wall and are independent of the ceiling system. Panels 380 or 510 mm wide usually satisfy a typical office building's heating requirements. Lengths up to 6 m are available. Figure 14 shows metal panels using a copper tube pressed into an aluminum extrusion. Some manufacturers also use graphite as a panel material.

Performance data for extruded aluminum panels vary with the copper tube/aluminum contact and test procedures used. Hydronic ceiling panels have a low thermal resistance and respond quickly to changes in space conditions. Table 1 gives thermal resistance values for various ceiling constructions.

Metal ceiling panels can be used with any of the all-air cooling systems described in Chapter 2. Chapters 17 and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describe how to calculate heating loads. Double-glazing and heavy insulation in outside walls reduce transmission heat losses. As a result, infiltration and reheat have become of greater concern. Additional design considerations include the following:

- Perimeter radiant heating panels extending not more than 1 m into the indoor space may operate at higher temperatures.
- Hydronic panels operate efficiently at low temperature and are suitable for condenser water heat reclaim systems.
- Locate ceiling panels adjacent to the outside wall and as close as possible to the areas of maximum load. The panel area within 1 m of the outside wall should have a heating capacity equal to or greater than 50% of the wall transmission load.
- Ceiling system designs based on passing return air through perforated modular panels into the plenum space above the ceiling are not recommended because much of this heat is lost to the return air system in heating mode.
- When selecting heating design temperatures for a ceiling panel surface or average water temperature, the design parameters are as follows:
  - Excessively high temperatures over the occupied zone will cause the occupant to experience a "hot head effect."
  - Temperatures that are too low can result in an oversized, uneconomical panel and a feeling of coolness at the outside wall.
  - Give ceiling panel location priority.
  - With normal ceiling heights of 2.4 to 2.8 m, panels less than 1 m wide at the outside wall can be designed for 113°C surface temperature. If panels extend beyond 1 m into the indoor space, the panel surface temperature should be limited to the values as given in Figure 15.
- Allow sufficient space above the ceiling for installation and connection of the piping that forms the panel ceiling.
- Hydronic ceiling panels provide a fast-response system (Watson et al. 1998).

Metal acoustic panels provide heating, cooling, sound absorption, insulation, and unrestricted access to the plenum space. They are easily maintained, can be repainted to look new, and have a life expectancy in excess of 30 years. The system is quiet, comfortable, draft-free, easy to control, and responsive. The system is a basic air-and-water system.

Metal heating panels, hydronic and electric, are applied to building perimeter spaces for heating in much the same way as finned-tube convectors. They can also be integrated into the ceiling design to provide a narrow band of panel heating around the perimeter of the building. The panel system offers advantages over baseboard or overhead air in appearance, comfort, operating efficiency and cost, maintenance, and product life.

ASHRAE *Standard* 138 discusses testing and rating of ceiling panels.

3.2 EMBEDDED SYSTEMS WITH TUBING IN CEILINGS, WALLS, OR FLOORS

Layout and design of embedded systems for heating and cooling begin early in the job. The type and location chosen influences the design and, conversely, thermal considerations may dictate which system type to use. ISO *Standard* 11855 provides an in-depth description of the design, installation, and control of embedded radiant systems. One of the following types of construction is generally used:

- Pipe or tube is embedded in the lower portion of a concrete slab, generally within 25 mm of its lower surface (Figure 16). If plaster is to be applied to the concrete, the piping may be placed directly on the wood forms. If the slab is to be used without plaster finish, the piping should be installed not less than 20 mm above the undersurface of the slab. The minimum coverage must comply with local building code requirements.

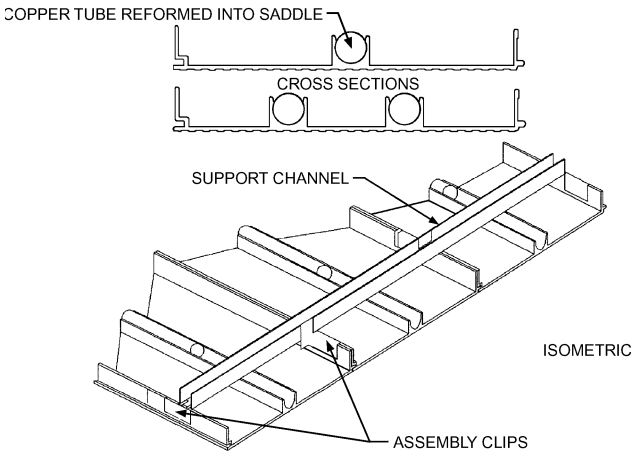


Fig. 14 Extruded Aluminum Panels with Integral Copper Tube

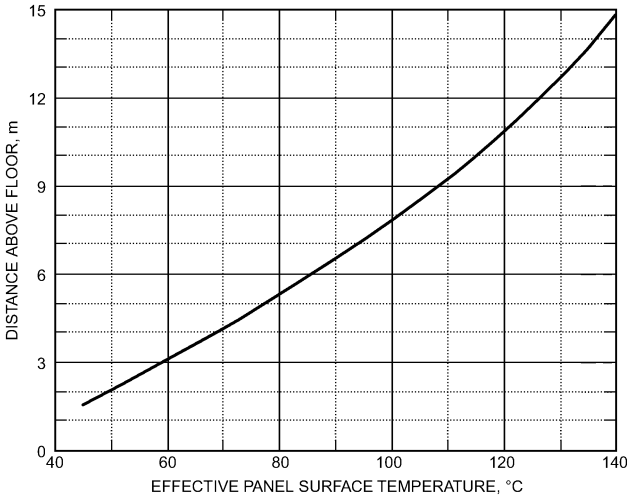


Fig. 15 Permitted Design Ceiling Surface Temperatures at Various Ceiling Heights

- Pipe or tube is embedded in a metal lath and plaster ceiling. If the lath is suspended to form a hung ceiling, the lath and heating coils are securely wired to the supporting members so that the lath is below, but in good contact with, the coils. Plaster is then applied to the metal lath, carefully embedding the coil as shown in Figure 17.
- Smaller-diameter copper or thermoplastic tube is attached to the underside of wire or gypsum lath. Plaster is then applied to the lath to embed the tube, as shown in Figure 18.
- Other forms of ceiling construction are composition board, wood paneling, etc., with warm-water piping, tube, or channels built into the panel sections.

Coils are usually laid in a sinusoidal pattern, although some header or grid-type coils have been used in ceilings. Coils are typically thermoplastic tube, spaced from 100 to 300 mm on centers, depending on the required heat flux, pipe or tube size, and other factors.

Where plastering is applied to pipe coils, a standard three-coat gypsum plastering specification is followed, with a minimum of 10 mm of cover below the tubes when they are installed below the lath. Generally, the surface temperature of plaster panels should not exceed 50°C, which may be satisfied by limiting the average water temperature to a maximum temperature of 60°C.

Insulation should be placed above the coils to reduce back loss, which is the difference between heat supplied to the coil and net useful heat output to the heated indoor space.

To protect the plaster installation and to ensure proper air drying, heat must not be applied to the panels for two weeks after all plastering work has been completed. When the system is started for the first time, water supplied to the panels should not be more than 10 K above the prevailing indoor air temperature and not in excess of 32°C.

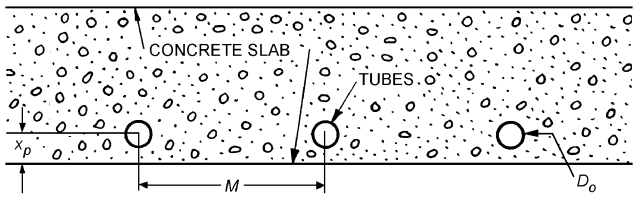


Fig. 16 Coils in Structural Concrete Slab

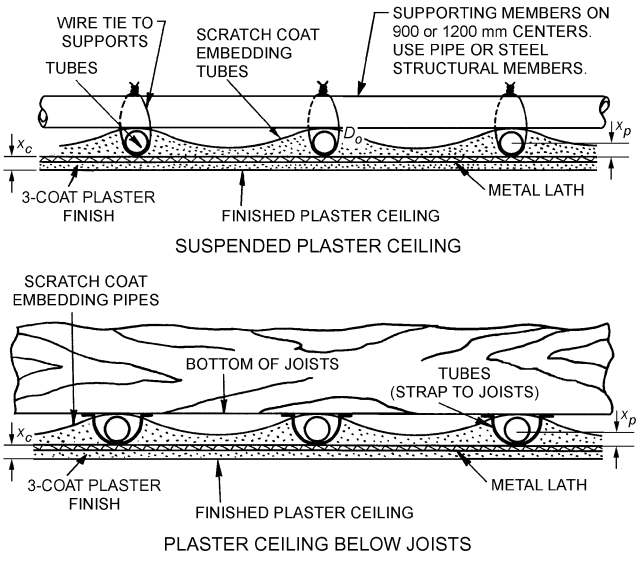


Fig. 17 Coils in Plaster Above Lath

Water should be circulated at this temperature for about two days, and then increased at a rate of about 3 K per day to 60°C.

During the air-drying and preliminary warm-up periods, there should be adequate ventilation to carry moisture from the panels. No paint or paper should be applied to the panels before these periods have been completed or while the panels are being operated. After paint and paper have been applied, an additional shorter warm-up period, similar to first-time starting, is also recommended.

Hydronic Wall Panels

Although piping embedded in walls is not as widely used as floor and ceiling panels, it can be constructed by any of the methods outlined for ceilings or floors. Its design is similar to other hydronic panels (see Equations [22] to [26]). Equations (5) and (12) give the heat flux at the surface of wall panels.

Hydronic Floor Panels

Interest has increased in floor heating with the introduction of nonmetallic tubing and new design, application, and control techniques. Whichever method is used for optimum floor output and comfort, it is important that heat be evenly distributed over the floor. Spacing is generally 100 to 300 mm on centers for the coils. Wide spacing under tile or bare floors can cause uneven surface temperatures.

Embedded Tubes or Pipes in Concrete Slab. Thermoplastic, rubber, ferrous, and nonferrous pipes, or composite tubes (e.g., thermoplastic tubes with aluminum sleeves) are used in floor slabs that rest on grade. Hydronic coils are constructed as sinusoidal-continuous coils or arranged as header coils with a spacing of 150 to 450 mm on centers. The coils are generally installed with 40 to 100 mm of cover above them. Insulation is recommended to reduce perimeter and back losses where the outer surface is exposed to the exterior. Figure 19 shows application of hydronic coils in slabs resting on grade. Coils should be embedded completely and should not rest on an interface. Any supports used for positioning heating coils should be nonabsorbent and inorganic. Reinforcing steel, angle iron, pieces of pipe or stone, or concrete mounds can be used. No wood, brick, concrete block, or similar

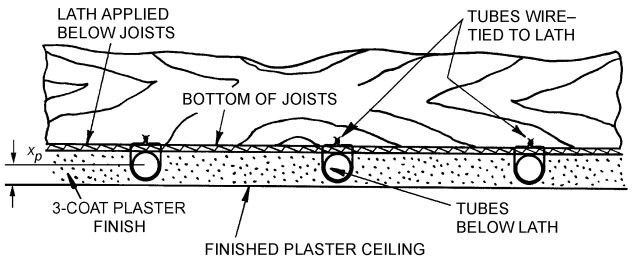


Fig. 18 Coils in Plaster Below Lath

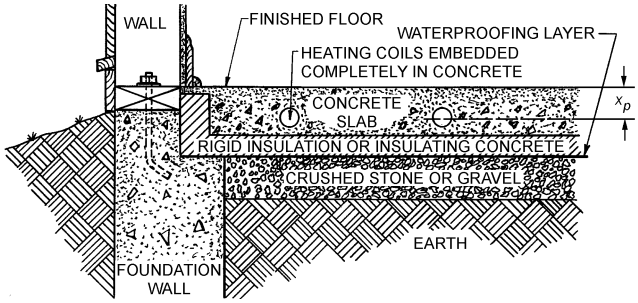


Fig. 19 Coils in Floor Slab on Grade

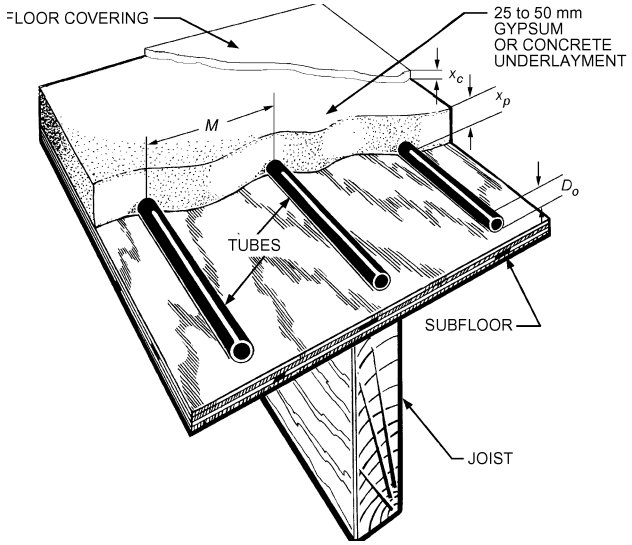


Fig. 20 Embedded Tube in Thin Slab

materials should support coils. A waterproofing layer is desirable to protect insulation and piping.

Where coils are embedded in structural load-supporting slabs above grade, construction codes may affect their position. Otherwise, the coil piping is installed as described for slabs resting on grade.

Embedded systems may fail sometime during their life. Adequate valves and properly labeled drawings help isolate the point of failure.

Suspended Floor Tubing or Piping. Piping may be applied on or under suspended wood floors using several construction methods. Piping may be attached to the surface of the floor and embedded in a layer of concrete or gypsum, mounted in or below the subfloor, or attached directly to the underside of the subfloor using metal panels to improve heat transfer from the piping. An alternative method is to install insulation with a reflective surface and leave an air gap of 50 to 100 mm to the subfloor. Whichever method is used for optimum floor output and comfort, it is important that heat be evenly distributed throughout the floor. Tubing generally has a spacing of 100 to 300 mm on centers. Wide spacing under tile or bare floors can cause uneven surface temperatures.

Figure 20 depicts construction with piping embedded in concrete or gypsum. The embedding material is generally 25 to 50 mm thick when applied to a wood subfloor. Gypsum products specifically designed for floor heating can generally be installed 25 to 40 mm thick because they are more flexible and crack-resistant than concrete. When concrete is used, it should be of structural quality to reduce cracking caused by movement of the wood frame or shrinkage. The embedding material must provide a hard, flat, smooth surface that can accommodate a variety of floor covers.

As shown in Figure 21, tubing may also be installed in the subfloor. The tubing is installed on top of the rafters between the subflooring members. Heat diffusion and surface temperature can be improved uniformly by adding metal heat transfer plates, which spread heat beneath the finished flooring.

A third construction option is to attach the tube to the underside of the subfloor with or without metal heat transfer plates. The construction is depicted in Figure 22.

Transfer from the hot-water tube to the surface of the floor is the important consideration in all cases. The floor surface temperature affects the actual heat transfer to the space. Any hindrance between the heated water tube and the floor surface reduces system effectiveness. The method that transfers and spreads heat evenly through the subfloor with the least resistance produces the best results.

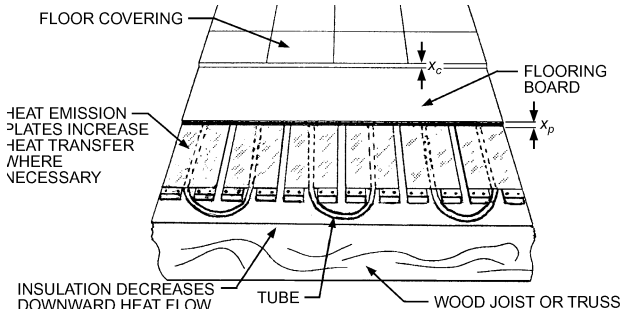


Fig. 21 Tube in Subfloor

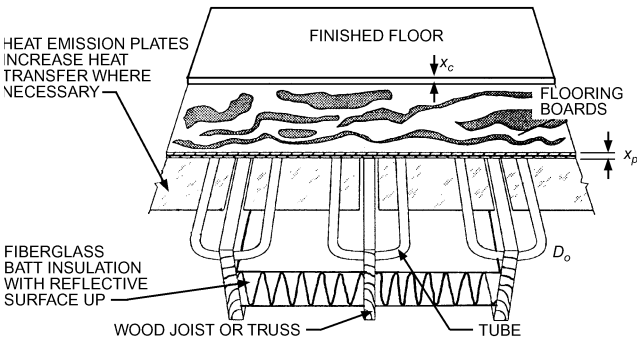


Fig. 22 Tube Under Subfloor

3.3 ELECTRICALLY HEATED RADIANT SYSTEMS

Several panel systems convert electrical energy to heat, raising the temperature of conditioned indoor surfaces and the indoor air. These systems are classified by the temperature of the heated system. Higher-temperature surfaces require less area to maintain occupant comfort. Surface temperatures are limited by the ability of the materials to maintain their integrity at elevated temperatures. The maximum effective surface temperature of floor panels is limited to what is comfortable to occupants' feet.

Electric Ceiling Panels

Prefabricated Electric Ceiling Panels. These panels are available in sizes 300 to 1800 mm wide by 600 to 3600 mm long by 13 to 50 mm thick. They are constructed with metal, glass, or semirigid fiberglass board or vinyl. Heated surface temperatures range from 40 to 150°C, with corresponding heat fluxes ranging from 270 to 1100 W/m^2 for 120 to 480 V services.

A panel of gypsum board embedded with insulated resistance wire is also available. It is installed as part of the ceiling or between joists in contact with a ceiling. Heat flux is limited to 240 W/m to maintain the board's integrity by keeping the heated surface temperature below 40°C. Nonheating leads are furnished as part of the panel.

Some panels can be cut to fit; others must be installed as received. Panels may be either flush or surface-mounted, and in some cases, they are finished as part of the ceiling. Rigid 600 by 1200 mm panels for lay-in ceilings (Figure 23) are about 25 mm thick and have a mass of 2.6 to 11 kg. Typical characteristics of an electric panel are listed in Table 4. Panels may also be (1) surface-mounted on gypsum board and wood ceilings or (2) recessed between ceiling joists. Panels range in size from 1200 mm wide to 2400 mm long. Their maximum power output is 1000 W/m^2.

Electric Ceiling Panel Systems. These systems are laminated conductive coatings, printed circuits, or etched elements nailed to the bottom of ceiling joists and covered by 13 mm gypsum board. Heat flux is limited to 190 W/m^2. In some cases, the heating element can be cut to fit available space. Manufacturers' instructions specify how to connect the system to the electric supply. Appropriate codes should be followed when placing partitions, lights, and air grilles adjacent to or near electric panels.

Electric Cables Embedded in Ceilings. Electric heating cables for embedded or laminated ceiling panels are factory-assembled units furnished in standard lengths of 25 to 550 m. These cable lengths cannot be altered in the field. The cable assemblies are normally rated at 9 W/m and are supplied in capacities from 200 to 5000 W in roughly 200 W increments. Standard cable assemblies are available for 120, 208, and 240 V. Each cable unit is supplied with 2 m nonheating leads for connection at the thermostat or junction box.

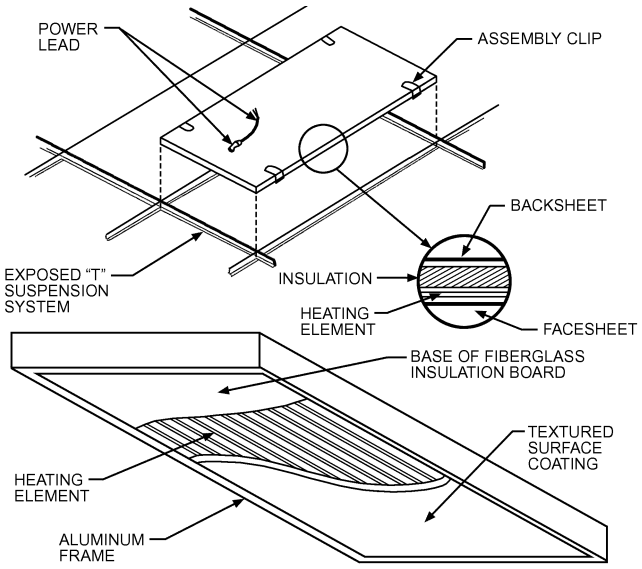


Fig. 23 Electric Heating Panels

Electric cables for panel heating have electrically insulated sleeves resistant to medium temperature, water absorption, aging effects, and chemical action with plaster, cement, or ceiling lath material. This insulation is normally made of polyvinyl chloride (PVC), which may have a nylon jacket. The thickness of the insulation layer is usually about 3 mm.

For plastered ceiling panels, the heating cable may be stapled to gypsum board, plaster lath, or similar fire-resistant materials with rust-resistant staples (Figure 24). With metal lath or other conducting surfaces, a coat of plaster (brown or scratch coat) is applied to completely cover the metal lath or conducting surface before the cable is attached. After the lath is fastened on and the first plaster coat is applied, each cable is tested for continuity of circuit and for insulation resistance of at least 100 kΩ measured to ground.

The entire ceiling surface is finished with a cover layer of thermally noninsulating sand plaster about 13 to 19 mm thick, or other approved noninsulating material applied according to manufacturer's specifications. The plaster is applied parallel to the heating cable rather than across the runs. While new plaster is drying, the system should not be energized, and the range and rate of temperature change should be kept low by other heat sources or by ventilation until the plaster is thoroughly cured. Vermiculite or other insulating plaster causes cables to overheat and is contrary to code provisions.

For laminated drywall ceiling panels, the heating cable is placed between two layers of gypsum board, plasterboard, or other thermally noninsulating fire-resistant ceiling lath. The cable is stapled directly to the first (or upper) lath, and the two layers are held apart by the thickness of the heating cable. It is essential that the space between the two layers of lath be completely filled with a noninsulating plaster or similar material. This fill holds the cable firmly in place and improves heat transfer between the cable and

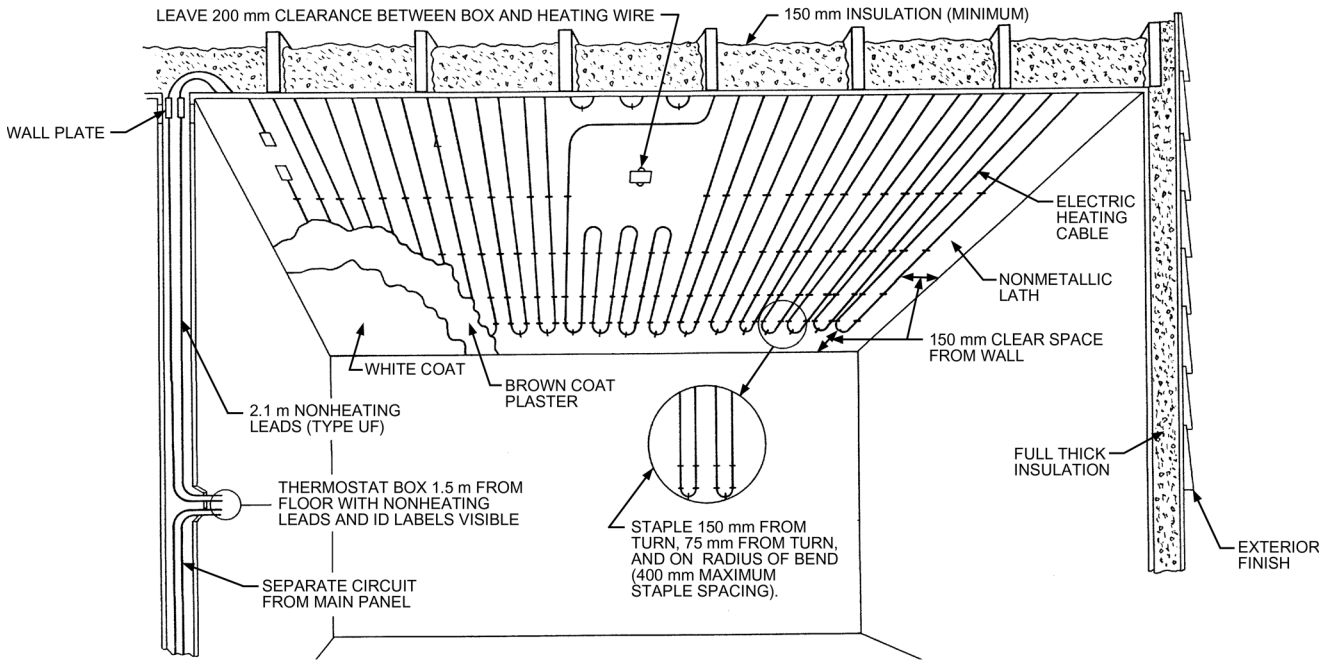


Fig. 24 Electric Heating for Wet Plaster Ceiling

Table 4 Characteristics of Typical Electric Panels

Resistor material	Graphite or nichrome wire
Relative heat intensity	Low, 540 to 1350 W/m^2
Resistor temperature	80 to 180°C
Envelope temperature (in use)	70 to 150°C
Thermal-radiation-generating ratio[a]	0.7 to 0.8
Response time (heat-up)	240 to 600 s
Luminosity (visible light)	None
Thermal shock resistance	Excellent
Vibration resistance	Excellent
Impact resistance	Excellent
Resistance to drafts or wind[b]	Poor
Mounting position	Any
Envelope material	Steel alloy or aluminum
Color blindness	Very good
Flexibility	Good—wide range of heat flux, length, and voltage practical
Life expectancy	Over 10 000 h

[a]Ratio of radiation heat flux to input power density (elements only).
[b]May be shielded from wind effects by louvers, deep-drawn fixtures, or both.

the finished ceiling. Failure to fill the space between the two layers of plasterboard completely may allow the cable to overheat in the resulting voids and may cause cable failure. The plaster fill should be applied according to manufacturer's specifications.

Electric heating cables are ordinarily installed with a 150 mm nonheating border around the periphery of the ceiling. A 200 mm clearance must be provided between heating cables and the edges of the outlet or junction boxes used for surface-mounted lighting fixtures. A 50 mm clearance must be provided from recessed lighting fixtures, trim, and ventilating or other openings in the ceiling.

Heating cables or panels must be installed only in ceiling areas that are not covered by partitions, cabinets, or other obstructions. However, it is permissible for a single run of isolated embedded cable to pass over a partition.

The *National Electrical Code*® (NFPA *Standard* 70) requires that all general electrical power and lighting wiring be run above the thermal insulation or at least 50 mm above the heated ceiling surface, or that the wiring be derated.

In drywall ceilings, the heating cable is always installed with the cable runs parallel to the joist. A 65 mm clearance between adjacent cable runs must be left centered under each joist for nailing. Cable runs that cross over the joist must be kept to a minimum. Where possible, these crossings should be in a straight line at one end of the indoor space

For cable having a heat flux of 9 W/m, the minimum permissible spacing is 40 mm between adjacent runs. Some manufacturers recommend a minimum spacing of 50 mm for drywall construction.

The spacing between adjacent runs of heating cable can be determined using the following equation:

$$M = 1000A_n/C \tag{28}$$

where

M = cable spacing, mm
A_n = net panel heated area, m^2
C = length of cable, m

Net panel area A_n in Equation (28) is the net ceiling area available after deducting the area covered by the nonheating border, lighting fixtures, cabinets, and other ceiling obstructions. For simplicity, Equation (28) contains a slight safety factor, and small lighting fixtures are usually ignored in determining net ceiling area.

Electrical resistance of the electric cable must be adjusted according to its temperature at design conditions (Ritter and Kilkis 1998):

$$R' = R\frac{[1 + \alpha_e(t_d - 20)]}{[1 + \alpha_o(t_d - 20)]} \tag{29}$$

where

R = electrical resistance of electric cable at standard temperature (20°C), Ω/m
α_e = thermal coefficient for material resistivity, °C^{-1}
α_o = thermal expansion coefficient, °C^{-1}
t_d = surface temperature of electric cable at operating conditions [see Equation (23)], °C

The 65 mm clearance required under each joist for nailing in drywall applications occupies one-fourth of the ceiling area if the joists are 400 mm on centers. Therefore, for drywall construction, the net area A_n must be multiplied by 0.75. Many installations have a spacing of 40 mm for the first 600 mm from the cold wall. Remaining cable is then spread over the balance of the ceiling.

Electric Wall Heating

Cable embedded in walls similar to ceiling construction is used in Europe. Because of possible damage from nails driven for hanging pictures or from building alterations, most U.S. codes prohibit such panels. Some of the prefabricated panels described in the preceding section are also used for wall panel heating.

Electric Floor Heating

Electric heating cable assemblies such as those used for ceiling panels are sometimes used for concrete floor heating systems. Because the possibility of cable damage during installation is greater for concrete floor slabs than for ceiling panels, these assemblies must be carefully installed. After the cable has been placed, all unnecessary traffic should be eliminated until the concrete layer has been placed and hardened.

Preformed mats are sometimes used for electric floor slab heating systems. These mats usually consist of PVC-insulated heating cable woven into or attached to metallic or glass fiber mesh. Such mats are available as prefabricated assemblies in many sizes from 0.2 to 9 m^2 and with heat fluxes from 160 to 270 W/m^2. When mats are used with a thermally treated cavity beneath the floor, a heat storage system is provided, which may be controlled for off-peak heating.

Mineral-insulated (MI) heating cable is another effective method of slab heating. MI cable is a small-diameter, highly durable, flexible heating cable composed of solid electric-resistance heating wire or wires surrounded by tightly compressed magnesium oxide electrical insulation and enclosed by a metal sheath. MI cable is available in stock assemblies in a variety of standard voltages, heat fluxes (power densities), and lengths. A cable assembly consists of the specified length of heating cable, waterproof hot-cold junctions, 2 m cold sections, UL-approved end fittings, and connection leads. Several standard MI cable constructions are available, such as single conductor, twin conductor, and double cable. Custom-designed MI heating cable assemblies can be ordered for specific installations.

Other outer-sleeve materials that are sometimes specified for electric floor heating cable include (1) silicone rubber, (2) lead, and (3) tetrafluoroethylene (Teflon®).

For a given floor heating cable assembly, the required cable spacing is determined from Equation (24). In general, cable heat flux and spacing should be such that floor panel heat flux is not greater than 160 W/m. Check the latest edition of the *National Electrical Code*® (NFPA *Standard* 70) and other applicable codes to obtain information on maximum panel heat flux and other required criteria and parameters.

Floor Heating Cable Installation. When PVC-jacketed electric heating cable is used for floor heating, the concrete slab is laid in two pours. The first pour should be at least 75 mm thick and, where practical, should be insulating concrete to reduce downward heat

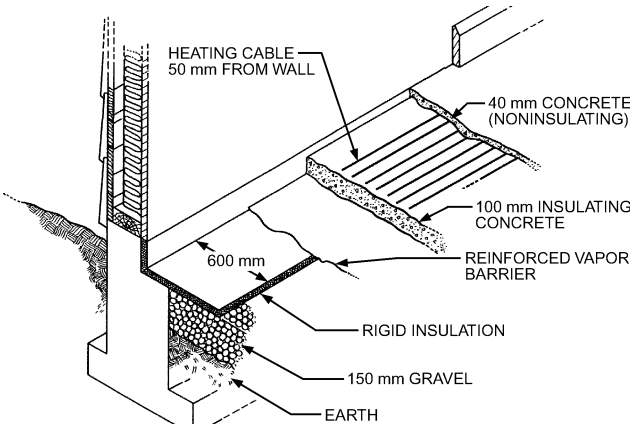


Fig. 25 Electric Heating Cable in Concrete Slab

loss. For a proper bond between the layers, the finish slab should be placed within 24 h of the first pour, with a bonding grout applied. The finish layer should be between 40 and 50 mm thick. This top layer must not be insulating concrete. At least 25 mm of perimeter insulation should be installed as shown in Figure 25.

The cable is installed on top of the first pour of concrete no closer than 50 mm from adjoining walls and partitions. Methods of fastening the cable to the concrete include the following:

- Staple the cable to wood nailing strips fixed in the surface of the rough slab. Daubs of cement, plaster of paris, or tape maintain the predetermined cable spacing.
- In light or uncured concrete, staple the cable directly to the slab using hand-operated or powered stapling machines.
- Nail special anchor devices to the first slab to hold the cable in position while the top layer is being poured.

Preformed mats can be embedded in the concrete in a continuous pour. The mats are positioned in the area between expansion and/or construction joints and electrically connected to a junction box. The slab is poured to within 40 to 50 mm of the finished level. The surface is rough-screeded and the mats placed in position. The final cap is applied immediately. Because the first pour has not set, there is no adhesion problem between the first and second pours, and a monolithic slab results. A variety of contours can be developed by using heater wire attached to glass fiber mats. Allow for circumvention of obstructions in the slab.

MI electric heating cable can be installed in concrete slab using either one or two pours. For single-pour applications, the cable is fastened to the top of the reinforcing steel before the pour is started. For two-layer applications, the cable is laid on top of the bottom structural slab and embedded in the finish layer. Proper spacing between adjacent cable runs is maintained by using prepunched copper spacer strips nailed to the lower slab.

4. DESIGN PROCEDURE

Panel design requires determining panel area, type, and arrangement as well as the supply water temperature and flow rate. Panel performance is directly related to indoor space conditions. Air-side design also must be established. Heating and cooling loads may be calculated by procedures covered in Chapters 17 and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. For cooling load calculations, the procedure based on the heat balance (HB) method is recommended, because other simplified methods developed for all-air systems (such as the radiant time series [RTS] method) are not as appropriate for radiant-system applications (Feng et al. 2013b, 2014). The procedure is as follows:

Sensible Cooling

1. Determine indoor design dry-bulb temperature, relative humidity, and dew point.
2. Calculate sensible and latent heat gains.
3. Establish minimum supply air quantity for ventilation.
4. Calculate latent cooling available from supply air.
5. Calculate sensible cooling available from supply air.
6. Determine remaining sensible cooling load to be satisfied by panel system.
7. Determine minimum permissible effective cooling panel surface temperature that will not lead to surface condensation at design conditions.
8. Determine AUST.
9. Determine necessary panel area for remaining sensible cooling.
10. Determine average panel cooling water (brine) temperature for given tube spacing, or determine necessary tube spacing if average panel cooling water (brine) temperature is known.

Sensible Heating

1. Designate indoor design dry-bulb temperature for panel heating.
2. Calculate room heat loss.
3. Determine AUST. Use Equation (14) to find surface temperatures of exterior walls and exposed floors and ceilings. Interior walls are assumed to have surface temperatures equal to indoor air temperature.
4. Calculate required effective surface temperature of panel. Refer to Figures 9 and 10 if AUST does not greatly differ from indoor air temperature. Otherwise, use Equations (5), (9), (10), (11), and (12) or refer to Figures 1 and 3.
5. Determine panel area. Refer to Figures 9 and 10 if AUST does not vary greatly from indoor air temperature.
6. Refer to manufacturers' data for panel surface temperatures higher than those given in Figures 9 and 10. For panels with several covers, average temperature of each cover and effective panel surface temperature must be calculated and compared to temperature-withstanding capacity for continuous operation of every cover material. For this purpose, Equation (23) may be used: add thermal resistances of all cover layers between panel surface and cover layer in question, then multiply by q and add to first two terms in Equation (23). This is t_{ha}, approximated temperature of the particular layer at design.
7. Determine tube spacing for a given average water temperature or select electric cable properties or electric mat size.
8. In a hydronic panel system, if tube spacing is known, determine required average water temperature.
9. Design panel arrangement.

Other Steps Common for Sensible Heating and Cooling

1. Check thermal comfort requirements in the following steps (see Chapter 9 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* and NRB [1981]).
   (a) Determine occupant's clothing insulation value and metabolic rate (see Tables 4, 7, 8, and 9 in Chapter 9 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*).
   (b) Determine optimum operative temperature at coldest point in conditioned space (see the Comfort Equations for Radiant Heating section in Chapter 9 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Note that the same equations may be adopted for panel cooling).
   (c) Determine MRT at the coldest point in the conditioned space (see Chapter 16 and Fanger [1972]).
   Note: If indoor air velocity is less than 0.4 m/s and MRT is less than 50°C, operative temperature may be approximated as the average of MRT and t_a.

(d) From the definition of operative temperature, establish optimum indoor design air temperature at coldest point in the room. If optimum indoor design air temperature varies greatly from designated design temperature, designate a new temperature.
(e) Determine MRT at hottest point in conditioned space.
(f) Calculate operative temperature at hottest point in conditioned space.
(g) Compare operative temperatures at hottest and coldest points. For light activity and normal clothing, the acceptable operative temperature range is 20 to 24°C (see NRB [1981] and ASHRAE *Standard* 55-2023). If the range is not acceptable, the panel system must be modified.
(h) Calculate radiant temperature asymmetry (NRB 1981). Acceptable ranges are less than 5 K for warm ceilings, 15 K for cool ceilings, 10 K for cool walls, and 27 K for warm walls at 10% local discomfort dissatisfaction (ASHRAE *Standard* 55-2023).

2. Determine water flow rate and pressure drop. Refer to manufacturers' guides for specific products, or use the guidelines in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Chapter 13 of this volume also has information on hydronic heating and cooling systems.
3. The supply and return manifolds must be carefully designed. If there are circuits of unequal coil lengths, the following equation may be used (Hansen 1985; Kilkis 1998) for a circuit i connected to a manifold with n circuits:

$$Q_i = (L_{eq}/L_i)^{1/r} Q_{tot} \tag{30}$$

where

$$L_{eq} = \left[\sum_{i=1}^{n} L_i^{-1/r}\right]^{-r}, \text{ m}$$

Q_i = flow rate in circuit i, L/s
Q_{tot} = total flow rate in supply manifold, L/s
L_i = coil length of hydronic circuit i, m
r = 1.75 for hydronic panels (Siegenthaler 1995)

Application, design, and installation of panel systems have certain requirements and techniques:

- As with any hydronic system, look closely at the piping system design. Piping should be designed to ensure that water of the proper temperature and in sufficient quantity is available to every grid or coil at all times. Proper piping and system design should minimize the detrimental effects of oxygen on the system. Reverse-return systems should be considered to minimize balancing problems.
- Hydronic panels can be used with two- and four-pipe distribution systems. Figure 26 shows a typical system arrangement. It is common to design for a 10 K temperature drop for heating across a given grid and a 3 K rise for cooling, but larger temperature differentials may be used, if applicable.
- Individual panels can be connected for parallel flow using headers, or for sinuous or serpentine flow. To avoid flow irregularities in a header-type grid, the water channel or lateral length should be greater than the header length. If the laterals in a header grid are forced to run in a short direction, using a combination series-parallel arrangement can solve this problem. Serpentine flow ensures a more even panel surface temperature throughout the heating or cooling zone.
- Noise from entrained air, high-velocity or high-pressure-drop devices, or pump and pipe vibrations must be avoided. Water velocities should be high enough to prevent separated air from accumulating and causing air binding. Where possible, avoid automatic air venting devices over ceilings of occupied spaces.

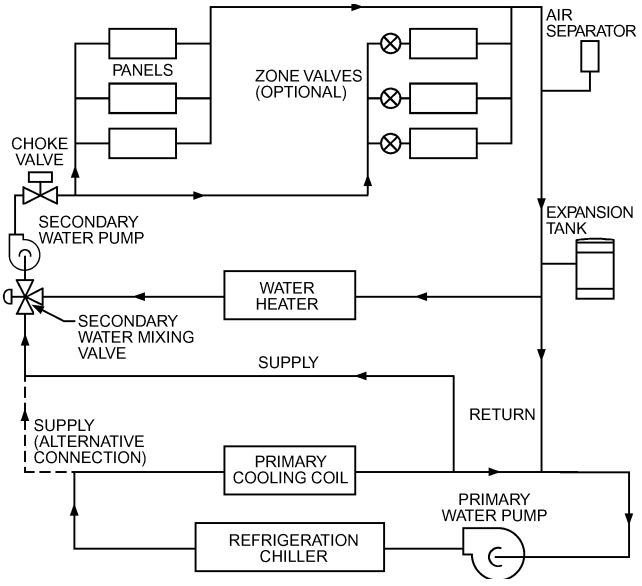


Fig. 26 Primary/Secondary Water Distribution System with Mixing Control

- Design piping systems to accept thermal expansion adequately. Do not allow forces from piping expansion to be transmitted to panels. Thermal expansion of ceiling panels must be considered.
- In hydronic systems, thermoplastic, rubber tubes, steel, or copper pipes are used widely in ceiling, wall, or floor panel construction. Where coils are embedded in concrete or plaster, no threaded joints should be used for either pipe coils or mains. Steel pipe should be the all-welded type. Copper tubing should be a soft-drawn coil. Fittings and connections should be minimized. Bending should be used to change direction. Solder-joint fittings for copper tube should be used with a medium-temperature solder of 95% tin, 5% antimony, or capillary brazing alloys. All piping should be subjected to a hydrostatic test of at least three times the working pressure. Maintain adequate pressure in embedded piping while pouring concrete.
- Placing the thermostat on a wall where it can observe both the outdoor exposed wall and the warm panel should be considered. The normal thermostat cover reacts to the warm panel, and thermal radiation from the panel to the cover tends to alter the control point so that the thermostat controls 1 to 2 K lower when the outdoor temperature is a minimum and the panel temperature is a maximum. Experience indicates that panel-heated spaces are more comfortable under these conditions than when the thermostat is located on a back wall.
- If throttling valve control is used, either the end of the main should have a fixed bypass, or the last one or two rooms on the mains should have a bypass valve to maintain water flow in the main. Thus, when a throttling valve modulates, there will be a rapid response.
- When selecting heating design temperatures for a ceiling panel surface, the design parameters are as follows:
  - Excessively high temperatures over the occupied zone cause the occupant to experience a "hot head effect."
  - Temperatures that are too low can result in an oversized, uneconomical panel and a feeling of coolness at the outside wall.
  - Locate ceiling panels adjacent to perimeter walls and/or areas of maximum load.
  - With normal ceiling heights of 2.4 to 2.8 m, panels less than 1 m wide at the outside wall can be designed for 113°C surface temperature. If panels extend beyond 1 m into the indoor space,

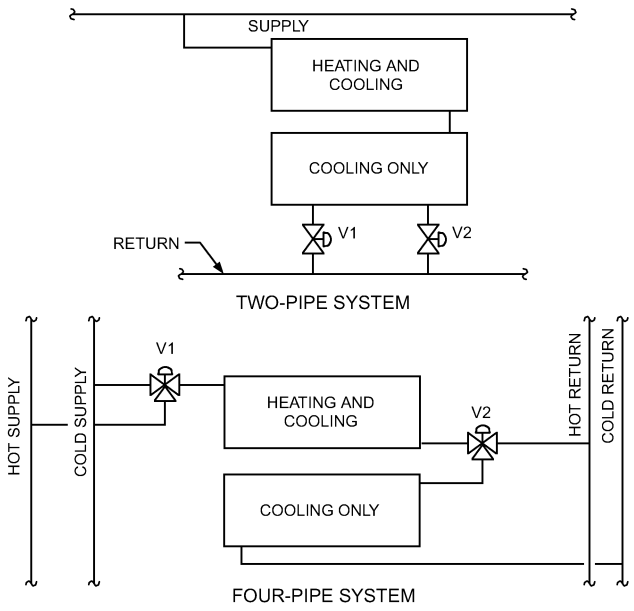


Fig. 27 Split Panel Piping Arrangement for Two-Pipe and Four-Pipe Systems

the panel surface temperature should be limited to the values given in Figure 15. The surface temperature of concrete or plaster panels is limited by construction.

- Floor panels are limited to surface temperatures of less than 29°C in occupied spaces for comfort reasons. Subfloor temperature may be limited to the maximum exposure temperature specified by the floor cover manufacturer.
- When the panel chilled-water system is started, the circulating water temperature should be maintained at indoor air temperature until the air system is completely balanced, the dehumidification equipment is operating properly, and building relative humidity is at design value.

When the panel area for cooling is greater than the area required for heating, a two-panel arrangement (Figure 27) can be used. Panel HC (heating and cooling) is supplied with hot or chilled water yearround. When chilled water is used, the controls activate panel CO (cooling only) mode, and both panels are used for cooling.

- To prevent condensation on the cooling panels, the panel water supply temperature should be maintained at least 0.5 K above the indoor design dew-point temperature. This minimum difference is recommended to allow for the normal drift of temperature controls for water and air systems, and also to provide a factor of safety for temporary increase in indoor relative humidity.
- Selection of summer design indoor dew point below 10°C generally is not economical.
- The most frequently applied method of dehumidification uses cooling coils. If the main cooling coil is six rows or more, the dew point of leaving air will approach the leaving water temperature. The cooling water leaving the dehumidifier can then be used for the panel water circuit.
- Several chemical dehumidification methods are available to control latent and sensible loads separately. In one application, cooling tower water is used to remove heat from the chemical drying process, and additional sensible cooling is necessary to cool the dehumidified air to the required system supply air temperature.
- When chemical dehumidification is used, hygroscopic chemical dew-point controllers are required at the central apparatus and at various zones to monitor dehumidification.
- When cooled ceiling panels are used with a variable-air-volume (VAV) system, the air supply rate should be near maximum volume to ensure adequate dehumidification before the cooling ceiling panels are activated.

Other factors to consider when using panel systems are

- Evaluate the panel system to take full advantage in optimizing the physical building design.
- Select recessed lighting fixtures, air diffusers, hung ceilings, and other ceiling devices to provide the maximum ceiling area possible for use as panels.
- The air-side design must be able to maintain relative humidity at or below design conditions at all times to eliminate any possibility of condensation on the panels. This becomes more critical if indoor space dry- and wet-bulb temperatures are allowed to drift for energy conservation, or if duty cycling of the fans is used.
- Do not place cooling panels in or adjacent to high-humidity areas, such as near a lobby entrance, or a kitchen.
- Anticipate thermal expansion of the ceiling and other devices in or adjacent to the ceiling.
- The design of operable windows should discourage unauthorized opening.

4.1 CONTROLS

Automatic controls for panel heating may differ from those for convective heating because of the thermal inertial characteristics of the panel and the increase in mean radiant temperature in the space under increasing loads. However, low-mass systems using thin metal panels or thin underlay with low thermal heat capacity may be successfully controlled with conventional control technology using indoor sensors. Many of the control principles for hot-water heating systems described in Chapters 13 and 15 also apply to panel heating. Because panels do not depend on air-side equipment to distribute energy, many control methods have been used successfully; however, a control interface between heating and cooling should be installed to prevent simultaneous heating and cooling.

High-thermal-mass panels such as concrete slabs require a control approach different from that for low-mass panels. Because of thermal inertia, significant time is required to bring such massive panels from one operating point to another, say from vacation setback to standard operating conditions. This will result in long periods of discomfort during the delay, then possibly periods of uncomfortable and wasteful overshoot. Careful economic analysis may reveal that nighttime setback is not warranted.

Once a slab is at operating conditions, the control strategy should be to supply the slab with heat at the rate that heat is being lost from the space (MacCluer et al. 1989). For hydronic slabs with constant circulator flow rates, this means modulating the temperature difference between the outgoing and returning water; this is accomplished with mixing valves, fuel modulation, or, for constant thermal power sources, pulse-width modulation (on/off control). For some applications, more advanced control techniques, such as model predictive control, may be used to optimize the balance of thermal comfort and energy consumption (Feng et al. 2015; Oldewurtel et al. 2012). Slabs with embedded electric cables can be controlled by pulse-width modulators such as the common round thermostat with anticipator or its solid-state equivalent.

Outdoor reset control, another widely accepted approach, measures the outdoor air temperature, calculates the supply water temperature required for steady operation, and operates a mixing valve

or boiler to achieve that supply water temperature. If the heating load of the controlled space is primarily a function of outdoor air temperature, or indoor temperature measurement of the controlled space is impractical, then outdoor reset control alone is an acceptable control strategy. When other factors such as solar or internal gains are also significant, indoor temperature feedback should be added to the outdoor reset.

In all panel applications, precautions must be taken to prevent excessive temperatures. A manual boiler bypass or other means of reducing the water temperature may be necessary to prevent new panels from drying out too rapidly.

Sensible Cooling Controls

The average water temperature in the hydronic circuit of radiant systems can be controlled either by mixing, by heat exchange, or by using the water leaving the dehumidifier. Other considerations are listed in the section on General Design Considerations. It is imperative to dry out the building space before starting the panel water system, particularly after extended down periods such as weekends. Such delayed starting action should be automated.

Radiant cooling systems require the following basic areas of temperature control: (1) exterior zones; (2) areas under exposed roofs, to compensate for transmission and solar loads; and (3) each typical interior zone, to compensate for internal loads. For optimum results, each area of the building with significantly different heating or cooling loads should be independently controlled.

Temperature control of the indoor air and panel water supply should not be a function of the outdoor weather. Normal thermostat drift is usually adequate compensation for the slightly lower temperatures desirable during winter weather. This drift should result in an indoor air temperature change of no more than 0.8 K. Control of interior zones is best accomplished by devices that reflect the actual presence of the internal load elements. Frequently, time clocks and current-sensing devices are used on lighting feeders.

Heating Slab Controls

In comfort heating, the effective surface temperature of a heated floor slab is held to a maximum of 27 to 29°C. As a result, when the heated slab is the primary heating system, thermostatic controls sensing air temperature should not be used to control the heated slab temperature; instead, the heating system should be wired in series with a slab-sensing thermostat. The remote sensing thermostat in the slab acts as a limit switch to control maximum surface temperatures allowed on the slab. The ambient sensing thermostat controls the comfort level. For supplementary slab heating, as in kindergarten floors, a remote sensing thermostat in the slab is commonly used to tune in the desired comfort level. Indoor-outdoor thermostats are used to vary the floor temperature inversely with the outdoor temperature. If the building heat loss is calculated for an outdoor temperature between 21 to –19°C, and the effective floor temperature range is maintained between 21 to 29°C with a remote sensing thermostat, the ratio of change in outdoor temperature to change in the heated slab temperature is 40:8, or 5:1. This means that a 5 K drop in outdoor temperature requires a 1 K increase in the slab temperature. An ambient sensing thermostat is used to vary the ratio between outdoor and slab temperatures. A time clock is used to control each heating zone if off-peak slab heating is desirable.

In heating systems, lowering nighttime air and surface temperatures can produce less satisfactory results in thermally massive radiant systems such as embedded tubing in concrete floors. These systems cannot respond to a quick increase or decrease in heating demand within the relatively short time required, resulting in a very slow reduction of the space temperature at night and a correspondingly slow pickup in the morning. Light panels, such as plaster or metal ceilings and walls, may respond to changes in demand quickly enough for satisfactory results from lowered nighttime air and panel temperatures. Berglund et al. (1982) demonstrated the speed of response on a metal ceiling panel to be comparable to that of convection systems. However, in cooling operation, thermally massive embedded systems can offer cost- and energy-saving opportunities through nighttime precooling when electricity costs are typically lower, as are outdoor dry- and wet-bulb temperatures.

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CHAPTER 7

COMBINED HEAT AND POWER SYSTEMS

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COMBINED heat and power (CHP) is the simultaneous production of electrical or mechanical power and useful thermal energy from a single energy source. By capturing and using the recovered thermal energy from an effluent stream that would otherwise be rejected to the environment, CHP (or *cogeneration*) systems can operate at utilization efficiencies greater than those achieved when heat and power are produced in separate processes and with potentially separate fuel sources, thus contributing to sustainable building solutions.

Recovered thermal energy from fuel used in reciprocating engines, steam or combustion turbines (including microturbines, which are typically less than 500 kW power generation capacity), Stirling engines, or fuel cells can be used in the following applications:

- Direct heating: exhaust gases or coolant fluids are used directly for drying processes, to drive an exhaust-heat-driven absorption chiller, to regenerate desiccant materials in a dehumidifier, or to operate a bottoming cycle
- Indirect heating: exhaust gases or coolant fluids are used to heat a secondary fluid (e.g., steam or hot water) for devices, to generate power, or to power various thermally activated technologies
- Latent heat: extracting the latent heat of condensation from a recovered flow of steam when the load served allows condensation (e.g., a steam-to-water exchanger) instead of rejecting the latent heat to a cooling tower (e.g., a full condensing turbine with a cooling tower)

There are many potential applications, including base-load power, peaking power where on-site power generation (distributed generation) is used to reduce the demand or high on-peak energy charges imposed by the electric energy supplier, back-up power, remote power, power quality, and CHP, providing both electricity and thermal needs to the site. Usually, customers own the small-scale, on-site power generators, but third parties may own and operate the equipment. Table 1 provides an overview of typical applications, technologies and uses of **distributed generation (DG)** and CHP systems.

On-site CHP systems are small compared to typical central station power plants. DG systems are inherently modular, which makes distributed power highly flexible and able to provide power where and when it is needed. DG and CHP systems can offer significant benefits, depending on location, rate structures, and application. Typical advantages of an on-site CHP plant include improved power reliability and quality, reduced energy costs, increased predictability of energy costs, lowered financial risk, use of renewable energy sources, reduced emissions, and faster response to new power demands because capacity additions can be made more quickly.

CHP system efficiency is not as simple as adding outputs and dividing by fuel inputs. Nevertheless, using what is normally waste exhaust heat yields overall efficiencies (η_O) of 50 to 70% or more (for a definition of overall efficiency, see the section on Performance Parameters).

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 1.10, Cogeneration Systems.

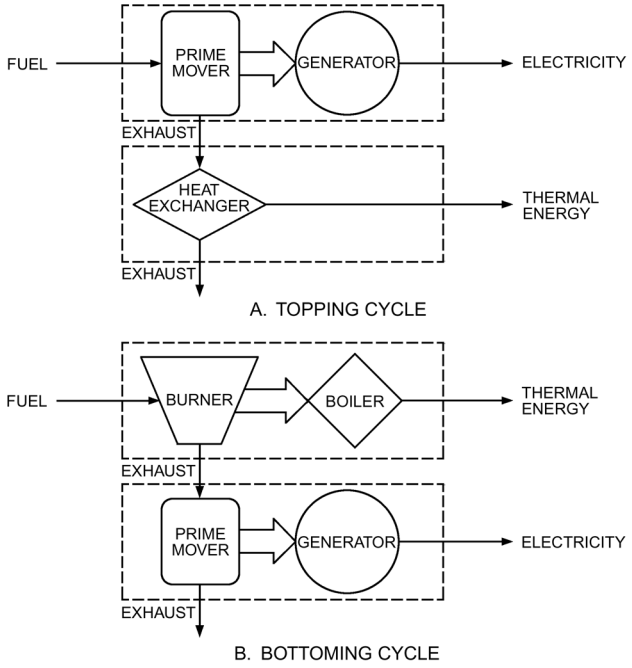


Fig. 1 CHP Cycles

CHP can operate on a topping, bottoming, or combined cycle. Figure 1 shows an example of topping and bottoming configurations. In a **topping cycle**, energy from the fuel generates shaft or electric power first, and thermal energy from the exiting stream is recovered for other applications such as process heat for cooling or heating systems. In a **bottoming cycle**, shaft or electric power is generated last from thermal energy left over after higher-level thermal energy has been used to satisfy thermal loads. *A typical topping cycle recovers heat from operation of a prime mover and uses this thermal energy for the process (cooling and/or heating). A bottoming cycle recovers heat from the process to generate power.* A **combined cycle** uses thermal output from a prime mover to generate additional shaft power (e.g., combustion turbine exhaust generates steam for a steam turbine generator).

Grid-isolated CHP systems, in which electrical power output is used on site to satisfy all site power and thermal requirements, are sometimes referred to as **total energy systems**. Grid-parallel CHP systems, which are actively tied to the utility grid, can, on a contractual or tariff basis, exchange power with or reduce load on (thus reducing capacity demand) the public utility. This may eliminate or lessen the need for redundant on-site back-up generating capacity and allows operation at maximum thermal efficiency when satisfying the facility's thermal load; this may produce more electric power than the facility needs.

Table 1 Applications and Markets for DG/CHP Systems

DG Technologies (in electrical power output capacity)	Standby Power	Base-Load Power Only	Demand Response Peaking	Customer Peak Shaving	Premium Power	Utility Grid Support	CHP	Applicable Market Sectors
Reciprocating engines: <50 kW to 16 MW	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	Commercial buildings, institutional, industrial, utility grid (larger units), waste fuels
Gas turbines: 500 kW to 50 MW		X		X	X	X	X	Large commercial, institutional, industrial, utility grid, waste fuels
Steam turbines: 500 kW to 100 MW		X			X		X	Institutional buildings/campuses, industrial, waste fuels
Microturbines: <30 to 500 kW	X	X	X	X	X	X	X	Commercial buildings, light industrial, waste fuels
Fuel cells: 5 kW to 2 MW		X			X	X	X	Residential, commercial, light industrial

Source: Adapted from NREL (2003).

CHP feasibility and design depend on the profiles (magnitude and duration) and coincidence of electrical and thermal loads, as well as on the selection of the prime mover, waste heat recovery system, and thermally activated technologies. Integrating design of the project's electrical and thermal requirements with the CHP plant is required for optimum economic performance. Matching the CHP plant's thermal/electric ratio with that of the building load is required for optimum economic benefit. The basic components of the CHP plant are the (1) prime mover and its fuel supply system, (2) generator and accessories, including interconnection and electrical protection systems, (3) waste heat recovery system, (4) thermally activated technologies, (5) control systems, (6) electrical and thermal transmission and distribution systems, and (7) connections to mechanical and electrical services.

This chapter describes the increasing role of CHP in sustainable design strategies, presents typical system designs, provides means and methods to understand system performance, and describes prime movers, such as reciprocating and Stirling engines, combustion and steam turbines, and fuel cells, and their characteristics for various uses. It also describes thermally activated technologies (TAT) such as heat recovery, absorption chillers, steam turbine-driven chillers, and desiccant dehumidifiers, as well as organic Rankine cycle (ORC) machines for waste heat recovery. Related issues, such as fuels, lubricants, instruments, noise, vibration, emissions, and maintenance, are discussed for each type of prime mover. Siting, interconnection, installation, and operation issues are also discussed. Thermal distribution systems are presented in Chapters 12 and 13.

Additional, in-depth guidance for CHP planning and design is provided in ASHRAE's (2015) *Combined Heat and Power Design Guide*.

1. TERMINOLOGY

Avoided cost. Incremental cost for the electric utility to generate or purchase electricity that is avoided through provision or purchase of power from a CHP plant.

Back-up power. Electric energy available from or to an electric utility during a power outage to replace energy ordinarily generated by the CHP plant.

Base load. Minimum electric or thermal load generated or supplied over one or more periods.

Black start. A start-up of an off-line, idle, non-spinning generation source without the electric utility.

Bottoming cycle. CHP plant in which energy put into the system is first applied to a thermal energy process; rejected heat from the process is then used for power production.

Capacity. Load for which an apparatus is rated (electrical generator or thermal system) at specific conditions.

Capacity credits. Value included in the utility's rate for purchasing energy, based on the savings accrued through reduction or postponement of new capacity resulting from purchasing electrical or thermal energy from CHP systems.

Capacity factor. Ratio of the actual annual output to the rated output over a specified time period.

Coefficient of performance (COP). Refrigeration or refrigeration plus thermal output energy divided by the energy input to the absorption device, refrigeration compressor, or steam turbine.

Combined heat and power (CHP). Simultaneous production of electrical or mechanical energy and useful thermal energy from a single energy stream.

Coproduction. Conversion of energy from a fuel (possibly including solid or other wastes) into shaft power (which may be used to generate electricity) and a second or additional useful form of energy. The process generally entails a series of topping or bottoming cycles to generate shaft power and/or useful thermal output. CHP is a form of coproduction.

Demand. Rate at which electric energy is delivered at a given instant or averaged over any designated time, generally over a period of less than 1 h.

Annual demand. Greatest of all demands that occur during a prescribed demand interval billing cycle in a calendar year.

Billing demand. Demand on which customer billing is based, as specified in a rate schedule or contract. It can be based on the contract year, a contract minimum, or a previous maximum, and is not necessarily based on the actual measured demand of the billing period.

Coincident demand. Sum of two or more demands occurring in the same demand interval.

Peak demand. Demand at the instant of greatest load.

Demand charge. Specified charge for electrical capacity on the basis of billing demand.

Demand factor. Average demand over specific period divided by peak demand over the same period (e.g., monthly demand factor, annual demand factor).

Demand-side management (DSM). Process of managing the consumption of energy, generally to optimize available and planned generation resources.

Economic coefficient of performance (ECOP). Output energy in terms of economic costs or value divided by input fuel in terms of energy purchased or produced, expressed in consistent units (e.g., kW) for each energy stream.

Efficiency. See the section on Performance Parameters.

Energy charge. Portion of the billed charge for electric service based on electric energy (kilowatt-hours) supplied, as contrasted with the demand charge.

Energy Information Administration (EIA). Independent agency in the U.S. Department of Energy that develops surveys, collects energy data, and analyzes and models energy issues.

Electric tariff. Statement of electrical rate and terms and conditions governing its application.

Grid. System of interconnected distribution and transmission lines, substations, and generating plants of one or more utilities.

Grid interconnection. System that manages the flow of power and serves as communication, control, and safety gateway between a CHP plant and an electric utility's distribution network.

Harmonics. Wave forms with frequencies that are multiples of the fundamental (60 or 50 Hz) wave. The combination of harmonics and the fundamental wave causes a nonsinusoidal, periodic wave. Harmonics in power systems result from nonlinear effects. Typically associated, for example, with rectifiers and inverters, arc furnaces, arc welders, and transformer magnetizing current. Both voltage and current harmonics occur.

Heat rate. Measure of generating station thermal efficiency, generally expressed in J/J or Mg of steam/kWh.

Heating value. Energy content in a fuel that is available as useful heat. The **higher heating value (HHV)** includes the energy needed to vaporize water formed during combustion, whereas the **lower heating value (LHV)** deducts this energy because it does not contribute to useful work.

Intermediate load. Range from base electric or thermal load to a point between base load and peak.

Interruptible power. Electric energy supplied by an electric utility subject to interruption by the electric utility under specified conditions.

Isolated plant. A CHP plant not connected to the electric utility grid.

Load factor. Load served by a system over a designated period divided by system capacity over the same period.

Off-peak. Periods when power demands are below average; for electric utilities, generally nights and weekends; for gas utilities, summer months.

Peak load. Maximum electric or thermal load in a stated period of time.

Peak shaving. Reduction of peak power demand using on-site power generation, thermally activated technologies, or other load-shifting device.

Point of common coupling. Point where a CHP system is connected to the local grid.

Power factor. Ratio of real power (kW) to apparent power (kVA) for any load and time; generally expressed as a decimal.

Premium power. High reliability power supply and/or high voltage/current power quality.

Reactive power. Reactive power exists in all alternating current (AC) power systems as current leads or lags voltages; inadequate reactive power reserves can contribute to voltage sags or even voltage collapse. CHP and/or on-site power systems can provide reactive power support where they are connected to the grid.

Shaft efficiency. Prime mover's shaft energy output divided by its energy input, in equivalent, consistent units. For a steam turbine, input can be the thermal value of the steam or the fuel value required to produce the steam. For a fuel-fired prime mover, it is the fuel input to the prime mover.

Standby power. Electric energy supplied by a CHP unit or other on-site generator during a grid outage.

Supplemental thermal. Heat required when recovered engine heat is insufficient to meet thermal demands.

Supplemental firing. Injection and combustion of additional fuel into an exhaust gas stream to raise its energy content (heat).

Transmission and distribution (T&D). System of wires, transformers, and switches that connects the power-generating plant and end user.

Topping cycle. CHP facility in which energy input to the facility is first used to produce useful power, and rejected heat from production is used for other purposes.

Total energy system. Form of CHP in which all electrical and thermal energy needs are met by on-site systems. A total energy system can be completely isolated or switched over to a normally disconnected electrical utility system for back-up.

Transmission. Network of high-voltage lines, transformers, and switches used to move electric power from generators to the distribution system.

Voltage flicker. Significant fluctuation of voltage (see Figure 27 in Chapter 57 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*).

Wheeling. Using one system's transmission facilities to transmit gas or power for another system.

See Chapter 57 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for a more detailed discussion of electricity terminology.

2. CHP SYSTEM CONCEPTS

2.1 CUSTOM-ENGINEERED SYSTEMS

Historically, CHP systems have been one-of-a-kind, custom-engineered systems. Because of the high cost of engineering, and technical, economic, environmental, and regulatory complexities, extraordinary care and skill are needed to successfully design and build custom-engineered CHP systems. For additional information, see the *Combined Heat and Power Design Guide* (ASHRAE 2015).

2.2 PACKAGED AND MODULAR SYSTEMS

Packaged/modular CHP systems are available from 5 to over 5000 kW of electric power. Packaged systems are defined as the integration of one or more power component (engines, microturbines, combustion turbines, and fuel cells), powered component (generators, compressors, pumps, etc.), heat recovery device [heat exchangers, heat recovery steam generators (HRSGs)], and/or thermally activated technology (absorption/adsorption chillers, steam turbines, ORCs, desiccant dehumidifiers), prefabricated on a single skid. A modular system is two or more packaged systems designed to be easily interconnected in the field. Modular systems are used largely because of shipping or installation size limitations. Packaged and modular systems often can be functionally tested in the factory before shipment, increasing the ease of commissioning. The simplest packaged and modular CHP systems are found in tightly integrated systems in general categories such as the following:

Reciprocating engine systems:

- Small engine generators (under 500 kW) recover jacket and exhaust heat in the form of hot water. Packaged systems include electronic safety and interconnection equipment.
- Small packaged and split-system engine heat pumps, integrating engines with complete vapor compression heat pumps and engine jacket and exhaust heat recovery, available under 175 kW.
- Engine packaged systems (typically 100 to 2000 kW) can drive generators, compressors, or pumps. Engine/generators recover at least jacket heat, and several modular systems integrate jacket water and exhaust systems to directly power single- and two-stage absorption chillers, providing power, heating, and cooling.

Microturbine systems:

- Microturbines integrate exhaust heat recovery (hot water) with electronic safety and interconnection equipment in a single compact package.
- Microturbines are easily integrated electrically and thermally (exhaust), providing ideal CHP systems delivering multiple power offerings, typically up to 500 kW, with hot-water systems or using integrated single- and two-stage absorption chillers (Wagner et al. 2009).

Combustion turbine systems:

- Modular systems have been developed in the 1 to 6 MW range, combining turbine generators, inlet cooling, exhaust control, heat recovery steam generators and/or absorption chillers.

2.3 LOAD PROFILING AND PRIME MOVER SELECTION

Selection of a prime mover is determined by the facility's thermal or electrical load profile. The choice depends on (1) the ability of the prime mover's thermal/electric ratio to match the facility loads, (2) the decision whether to parallel with the public utility or be totally independent, (3) the decision whether to sell excess power to the utility, if allowable, and (4) the desire to size a proposed CHP system to the thermal base load. The form and quality of the required thermal energy is also very important. If high-pressure steam is required, the reciprocating engine is less attractive as a thermal source than a combustion turbine.

Regardless of how the prime mover is chosen, the degree of use of the available heat determines the overall system efficiency; this is the critical factor in economic feasibility. Therefore, the prime mover's thermal/electric ratio and load must be analyzed as a first step towards making the best choice of type and size of the proposed prime mover. Maximizing efficiency is generally not as important as maximizing thermal and electric use.

CHP paralleled with the utility grid can operate at peak efficiency if (1) the electric generator can be sized to meet the valley of the thermal load profile, operate at a base electrical load (100% full load) at all times, and purchase the balance of the site's electric needs from the utility; or (2) the electric generators are sized for 100% of the site's electrical demand and recovered heat can be fully used at that condition, with additional thermal demands met by supplementary means and excess power sold to a utility or other electric energy supplier or broker.

Heat output to the primary process is determined by the engine type and load. It must be balanced with actual requirements by supplementation or by rejecting excess heat through peripheral devices such as radiators or cooling towers. Similarly, if more than one level of heat is required, controls are needed to (1) reduce heat from a higher level, (2) supplement heat if it is not available, or (3) reject heat when availability exceeds requirements.

In CHP plants with more than one prime mover, controls must be added to balance the power output of the prime movers and to balance reactive power flow between the generators. Generally, an isolated system requires that the prime movers supply the needed electrical output, with the amount of heat availability controlled by the electrical output requirements. Any imbalance in heat requirements results in burning supplemental fuels or wasting surplus recoverable heat through the heat rejection system.

Supplemental firing and heat loss can be minimized during parallel operation of the generators and the electric utility system grid by **thermal load following** (adjusting the prime mover throttle for the required amount of heat). The amount of electrical energy generated then depends on heat requirements; imbalances between the thermal and electrical loads are carried by the electric utility either through absorption of excess generation or by delivering supplemental electrical energy to the electrical system.

Similarly, electrical load tracking controls the electric output of the generator(s) to follow the site's electrical load, while using, selling, storing, or discarding (or any combination of these methods) the thermal energy output. To minimize waste of thermal energy, the CHP plant can be sized to track the electrical load profile up to the generator capacity, which is selected for a thermal output that matches the valley of the thermal profile. Careful selection of the prime mover type and model is critical in providing the correct thermal/electric ratio to minimize electric and thermal waste. Supplemental electric power is purchased and/or thermal energy generated by other means when the thermal load exceeds the generator's maximum capacity.

Analysis of these tracking scenarios requires either a fairly accurate set of coincident electric and thermal profiles typical for a variety of repetitious operating modes, or a set of daily, weekend, and holiday accumulated electrical and thermal consumption requirements. Where thermal load profiles are not necessarily coincident with electric load profiles, thermal energy storage may be used to maximize load factor.

2.4 PEAK LOAD SHAVING

High on-peak energy charges and/or electrical demand charges in many areas, ratchet charges (minimum demand charge for 11 months = x% of the highest annual peak, leading to an actual payment that in many months is more than the demand charge based on the actual measured usage), and utility capacity shortages have led to **demand-side management (DSM)** by utilities and their consumers. In these cases, a strategy of peak shaving or generating power only during peak cost or peak demand situations may be used. Peak thermal loads may also be shaved off by thermal storage systems of various types. These are especially important, because electrical power may be exchanged by the grid but thermal loads may not be exchanged so easily, except in district energy systems. Peak load shaving of thermal loads may also help to restore the power-to-heat ratio on the demand site and to match the power-to-heat ratio on the CHP side.

2.5 CONTINUOUS-DUTY STANDBY

An engine that drives a refrigeration compressor can be switched over automatically to drive an electrical generator in the event of a power failure (Figure 2), if loss of compressor service can be tolerated in an emergency.

If engine capacity of a dual-service system equals 150 or 200% of the compressor load, power available from the generator can be delivered to the utility grid during normal operation. Although induction generators may be used for this application, a synchronous generator is required for emergency operation if there is a grid outage.

Dual-service arrangements have the following advantages:

- In comparison to two engines in single service, required capital investment, space, and maintenance are lower, even after allow-

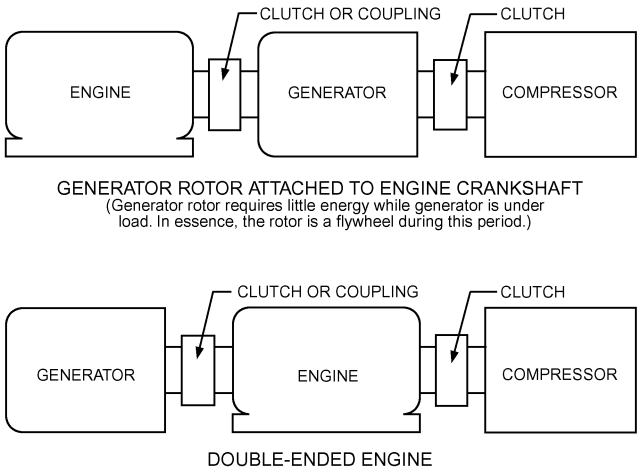


Fig. 2 Dual-Service Applications

ing for the additional controls needed with dual-service installations.
- Because they operate continuously or on a regular basis, dual-service engines are more reliable than emergency (reserved) single-service engines.
- Engines that are in service and running can be switched over to emergency power generation with minimal loss of continuity.

2.6 POWER PLANT INCREMENTAL HEAT RATE

Typically, CHP power plants are rated against incremental heat rates (and thus incremental thermal efficiency) by comparing the incremental fuel requirements with the base case energy needs of a particular site. For example, if a gas engine generator with a design heat rate of 3 J/J (10.8 MJ/kWh or 33% thermal efficiency) provided steam or hot water through waste heat recovery to a particular system that would save 1 J/J energy input, the incremental heat rate of the CHP power plant would be only 2 J/J, which translates to an efficiency of 50%. If the same system is applied to another site where only 0.5 J/J of the recovered heat can be used (against the availability of 1 J/J), the incremental heat rate for the same power plant rises to 2.5 J/J, with efficiency dropping to 43%. Thus, CHP power plant performance really depends on the required thermal/electric ratio for a particular application, and it is only according to this ratio that the type of CHP configuration should be chosen.

A system that requires 1000 kWh electrical energy and 3200 kg low-pressure steam at 200 kPa (gage) (thermal/electric ratio of about 2.4, or 3.2 kg steam per kilowatt-hour) can be used to further illustrate measuring CHP system performance. In this example, a 1000 kW gas engine-generator CHP system provides a maximum of 700 kg/h steam, with the balance of 2500 kg/h to be met by a conventional boiler with 75% thermal efficiency. Thus, the total power requirement is about 3.0 MW (34% efficient) for the gas engine and 2.17 MW for the boiler input, for a total of 5.17 MW.

If a gas turbine CHP system with the same power and heat requirements is used instead, with a heat rate of 4 kW per kilowatt (efficiency of 25%), it would supply both 1000 kW of power and 3200 kg/h steam with only 4 MW fuel input. Thus, the gas engine-generator, although having a very high overall efficiency, is not suitable for the combination system because it would use 1.17 MW (about 29%) more power than the gas turbine for the same total output.

3. PERFORMANCE PARAMETERS

3.1 HEATING VALUE

Natural gas is often selected as the fuel for CHP systems, although the same considerations discussed here apply to biofuels and fossil fuels (Peltier 2001). There are two common ways to define the energy content of fuel: higher heating value and lower heating value.

Turbine, microturbine, engine, and fuel cell manufacturers typically rate their equipment using **lower heating value (LHV)**, which accurately measures combustion efficiency; however, LHV neglects the energy in water vapor formed by combustion of hydrogen in the fuel. This water vapor typically represents about 10% of the energy content. LHVs for natural gas are typically 33.5 to 35.5 MJ/m^3.

Higher heating value (HHV) for a fuel includes the full energy content as defined by bringing all products of combustion to 25°C. Natural gas typically is delivered by the local distribution company with values of 37 to 39 MJ/m^3 on this HHV basis.

Consumers purchase natural gas in terms of its HHV; therefore, performances of CHP systems as well as the electric grid for comparison are calculated in HHV.

The **net electric efficiency** η_E of a generator can be defined by the first law of thermodynamics as net electrical energy output W_E divided by fuel input Q_{fuel} in terms of kilowatt-hours of thermal energy content. See EU Directive 2004/8/EC and EU Decision 2011/877/EU for the definitions of the net electrical output attributable to the CHP system and the harmonized reference efficiency values, respectively.

$$\eta_E = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel}}$$

A CHP system, by definition, produces useful thermal energy (heat) as well as electricity. If the first law is applied, adding the useful thermal energy Q_{TH}, converted from megajoules to kilowatt-hours, to the net electrical output and dividing by the fuel consumed (which is how virtually all CHP system efficiencies are reported), the result is the overall CHP system efficiency η_O, which does not account for the relative useful work potential (exergy) of the two different energy streams:

$$\eta_O = \frac{W_E + \sum Q_{TH}}{Q_{fuel}}$$

According to the second law of thermodynamics, the two different energy streams have different useful work potentials. Thus, heat and electricity are not interchangeable and are not algebraically additive. The first law describes the quantity of the two energy streams, whereas the second law describes their quality or useful work potential. Electrical energy is generally of higher value because it can do many types of work, and, in theory, 100% of it can be converted into thermal energy. Thermal energy is more limited in use and is converted to work at rates usually much lower than 100% conversion. The theoretical maximum efficiency at which thermal energy can be converted to work is the Carnot efficiency, which is a function of the quality, or temperature, of the thermal energy and is defined as $(T_{high} - T_{low})/T_{high}$. T_{low} is the dead-state temperature, which means the lowest temperature in the environment of the CHP system that the heat eventually becomes in equilibrium with the environment. This temperature may be selected to be the ground temperature, air temperature (less stable), or the temperature of a large heat reservoir in the neighborhood, such as a lake or sea.

3.2 CHP ELECTRIC EFFECTIVENESS

The current methodology of using net electric efficiency η_E and overall efficiency η_O either separately or in combination does not fully describe CHP performance because

- η_E gives no value to thermal output
- η_O is an accurate measure of fuel use but does not differentiate the relative values of the energy outputs, and is not directly comparable to any performance metric representing separate power and thermal generation

CHP electric effectiveness ε_{EE} is a single metric that recognizes and adequately values the multiple outputs of CHP systems and allows direct comparison of system performance to the conventional electric grid and competing technologies. This more closely balances the output values of CHP systems and allows CHP system development to be evaluated over time.

CHP electric effectiveness views the CHP system as primarily providing thermal energy, with electricity as a by-product. It is then defined as net electrical output divided by incremental fuel consumption of the CHP system above the fuel that would have been required to produce the system's useful thermal output by conventional means. This approach credits the system's fuel consumption to account for the value of the thermal energy output, and measures how effective the CHP system is at generating power (or mechanical energy) once the thermal needs of a site have been met. This

metric is most effective when used on a consistent and standardized basis, meaning

- The metric measures a single point of performance (design point)
- The design point for power generation is measured at ISO conditions (for combustion turbines, microturbines, and fuel cells, 15°C, 60% rh, sea level, per ISO *Standard* 3977-2; for reciprocating engines, 25°C, 30% rh, and 100 kPa per ISO *Standard* 3046-1)
- The performance evaluates fuel input and CHP outputs at design point only
- HHV is used because it measures the true values of performance in relation to fuel use and fuel cost (HHV is more commonly used to compare energy systems, is the basis of fuel purchases, and is the basis of emissions regulation)

Power and Heating Systems

For CHP systems delivering electric and thermal power (in the form of steam and/or hot water, or direct heating), the CHP electric effectiveness is defined as

$$\varepsilon_{EE} = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel} - \sum(Q_{TH}/\alpha)}$$

where α is the efficiency of the conventional technology that otherwise would be used to provide the useful thermal energy output of the system (for steam or hot water, a conventional boiler); see Table 2.

Examples 1 to 5 demonstrate how to apply this metric. The basis for comparison is a 25% HHV efficient electric power source. Performance values for larger combustion turbines, reciprocating engines, and fuel cells vary significantly.

Example 1. Separate Power and Conventional Thermal Generation. A facility supplies its power and thermal requirements by two separate systems: a conventional boiler for its thermal needs and a power-only generator for electricity.

Conventional Boiler: 100 units of fuel are converted into 80 units of heat and 20 units of exhaust energy as shown in Figure 3.

Power-Only Generator: A 25% HHV efficient electric generator consumes 160 units of fuel and produces 40 units of electricity and 120 units of exhaust energy (Figure 4).

The performance metrics for this separate approach to energy supply are as follows:

$$\eta_E = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40}{160} = 0.25$$

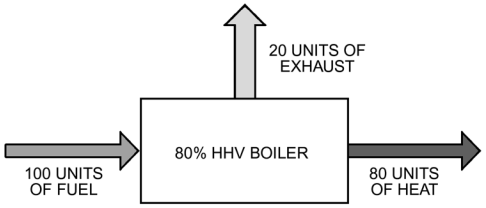


Fig. 3 Conventional Boiler for Example 1

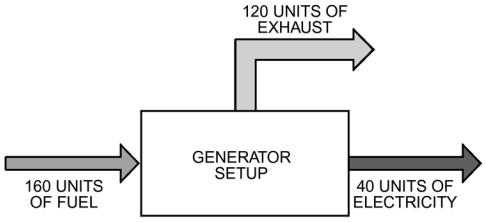


Fig. 4 Power-Only Generator for Example 1

$$\eta_O = \frac{W_E + \sum Q_{TH}}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40 + 80}{160 + 100} = 0.46$$

$$\varepsilon_{EE} = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel} - \sum(Q_{TH}/\alpha)} = \frac{40}{260 - (80/0.80)} = 0.25$$

Example 2. Combined Power and Thermal Generation (Hot Water/Steam). A CHP system is used to meet the same power and thermal requirements as in Example 1, with a 25% HHV efficient generator and a 67% efficient heat recovery heat exchanger (e.g., a 315°C airstream reduced to 115°C exhaust and yielding 93°C hot water). The performance parameters for this combined system are shown in Figure 5.

$$\eta_E = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40}{160} = 0.25$$

$$\eta_O = \frac{W_E + \sum Q_{TH}}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40 + 80}{160} = 0.75$$

$$\varepsilon_{EE} = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel} - \sum(Q_{TH}/\alpha)} = \frac{40}{160 - (80/0.80)} = 0.67$$

Note that η_E for both systems (Example 1's separate generation and Example 2's CHP) is the same, but the CHP system uses less fuel to produce the required outputs, as shown by the differences in overall efficiency (η_O = 75% for CHP versus η_O = 46% for separate systems); see Figure 6. However, this metric does not adequately account for the relative values of the thermal and electric outputs. The electric effectiveness metric, on the other hand, nets out the thermal energy, leaving an ε_{EE} of 67% for the CHP system.

Example 3. Combined Power and Thermal Generation (Direct Exhaust Heat). In some cases, exhaust gases are clean enough to be used for heating directly (e.g., greenhouses and drying where microturbine and gas turbine exhaust is used). For these cases, the thermal recovery efficiency is the difference between exhaust gas temperature and ambient temperature, where delivered exhaust gas is divided by the difference between exhaust gas temperature and outdoor ambient temperature. Direct exhaust gas delivery is a direct-contact form of heating; thus, heat transfer losses are minimal. For a 25% efficient electric generator exhausting into a greenhouse with an internal temperature of 38°C, ther-

Table 2 Values of α for Conventional Thermal Generation Technologies

Fuel	α
Natural gas boiler	0.80
Biomass boiler	0.65
Direct exhaust*	1.0

*Direct drying using exhaust gas is analogous to using flue stack gas for the same purpose; therefore, a direct one-to-one equivalence is best for comparison.

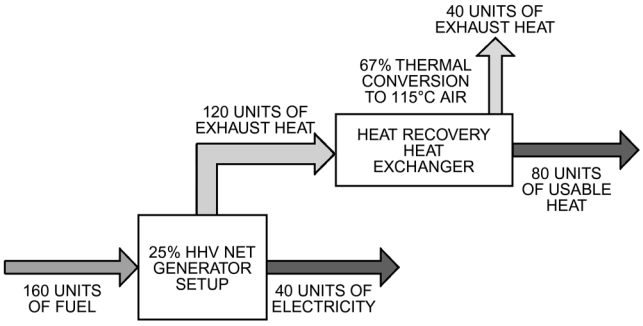


Fig. 5 Performance Parameters for Combined System for Example 2

mal recovery efficiency = (315°C – 38°C)/(315°C – 15°C) = 92% (note that 15°C is the ISO rating condition for microturbines per ISO *Standard* 3977-2).

Performance parameters for this combined system are shown in Figure 7, and system boundaries are shown in Figure 8.

$$\eta_E = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40}{160} = 0.25$$

$$\eta_O = \frac{W_E + \sum Q_{TH}}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40 + 110}{160} = 0.94$$

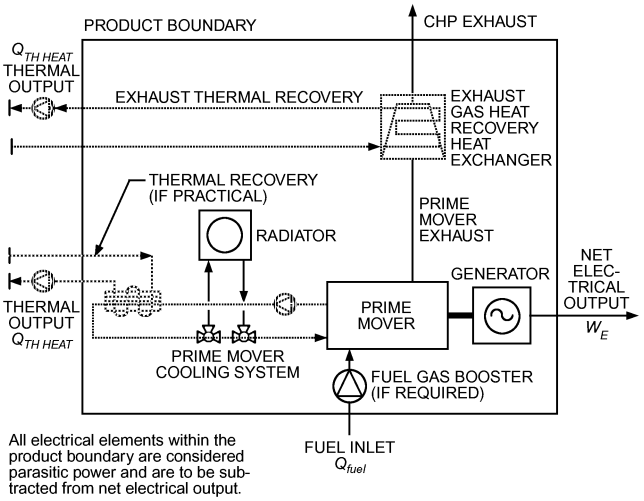


Fig. 6 CHP Power and Heating Energy Boundary Diagram for Example 2

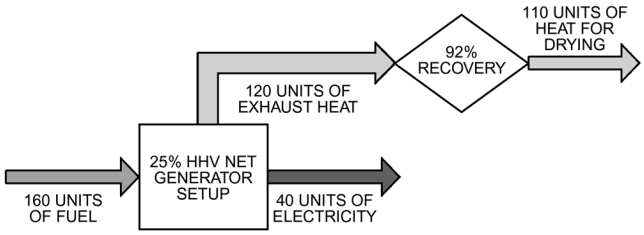


Fig. 7 Performance Parameters for Example 3

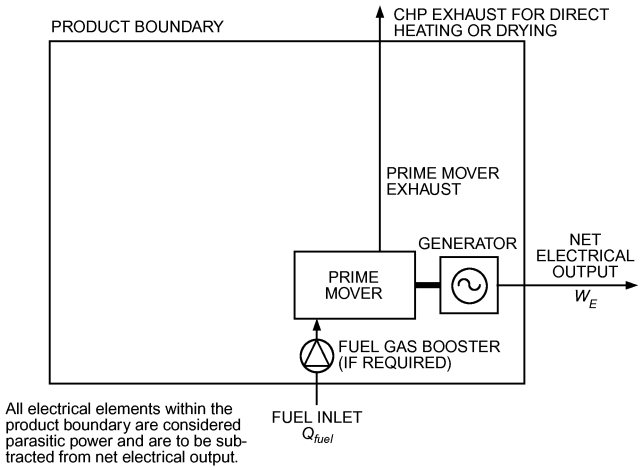


Fig. 8 CHP Power and Direct Heating Energy Boundary Diagram for Example 3

$$\varepsilon_{EE} = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel} - \sum(Q_{TH}/\alpha)} = \frac{40}{160 - (110/1.00)} = 0.80$$

Example 4. Combined Power and Thermal Generation (Combustion Turbine [CT] Without Cofired Duct Burner). In this example, exhaust gas from the 25% efficient electrical combustion turbine generator setup is assessed first without any exhaust enhancement, and then the same system is assessed with temperature and energy content enhancement using cofiring of additional fuel in a duct burner placed in the exhaust and using a heat recovery steam generator (HRSG). The basis for this example is using fuel input and steam output data from a simple cycle gas turbine, as shown in Figures 9 and 10.

$$\eta_E = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40}{160} = 0.25$$

$$\eta_O = \frac{W_E + \sum Q_{TH}}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40 + 69}{160} = 0.68$$

$$\varepsilon_{EE} = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel} - \sum(Q_{TH}/\alpha)} = \frac{40}{160 - (69/0.80)} = 0.54$$

Note that, based on this system approach, cofiring has no effect on η_E because no fuel flows to the duct burner in power-only mode. However, ε_{EE} increases from 0.54 to 0.71 (Figure 11) as shown in Example 5.

Example 5. Combined Power and Thermal Generation (Combustion Turbine [CT] with Cofired Duct Burner) (Figure 12).

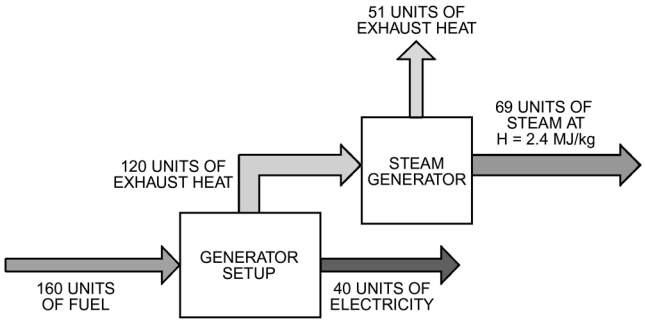


Fig. 9 Performance Parameters for Example 4

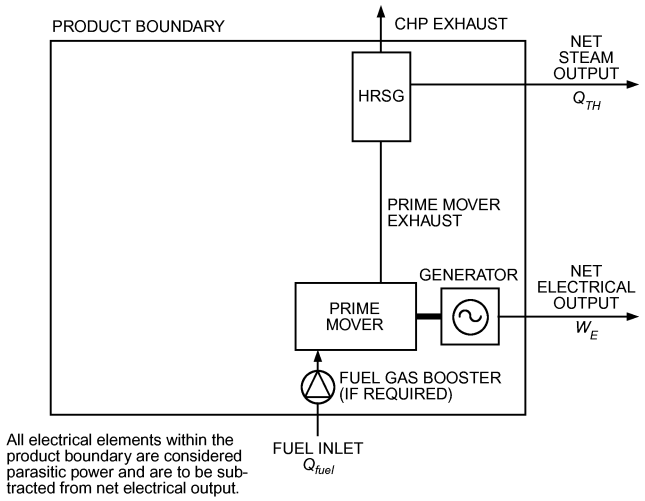


Fig. 10 CHP Power and HRSG Heating Without Duct Burner Energy Boundary Diagram for Example 4

$$\eta_E = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40}{160} = 0.25$$

$$\eta_O = \frac{W_E + \sum Q_{TH}}{Q_{fuel}} = \frac{40 + 182}{284} = 0.78$$

$$\varepsilon_{EE} = \frac{W_E}{Q_{fuel} - \sum (Q_{TH}/\alpha)} = \frac{40}{284 - (182/0.80)} = 0.71$$

Table 3 shows a summary of the performance metric results of Examples 1 to 5.

Demonstrating the effect of increasing efficiency, Table 4 presents the results from using a combustion turbine (CT) that delivers 33% efficiency. Notice that η_E is, as expected, higher in all examples, and η_O is higher in all but the cofired duct burner case. Cofiring uses exhaust gas heat very effectively, with a 75% recovery rate, accounting for the dominance of thermal recovery from a primary-energy basis and consequently lower η_O associated with the higher η_E system. ε_{EE}, like coefficient of performance (COP), can exceed 1.00, which demonstrates the primary-energy power CHP systems demonstrated in Examples 3 and 4. ε_{EE}, like η_O, exhibits the same pattern in Table 4 as in Table 3.

The implication is that greater use of the thermal energy results in a higher electric effectiveness (Figure 13). All of the example systems, except a low electrically efficient generator with separate boiler, are superior in electrical effectiveness to the delivered efficiency of the electric grid.

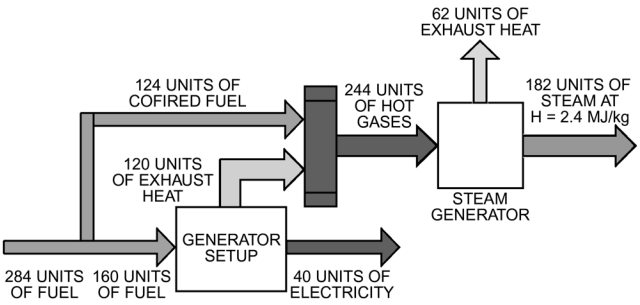


Fig. 11 Cofiring Performance Parameters for Example 5

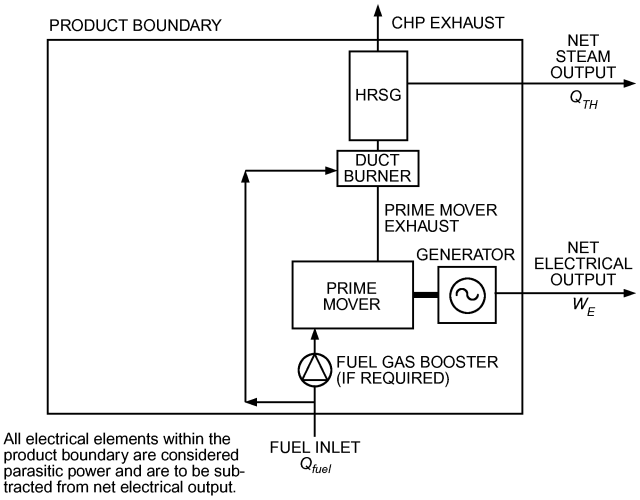


Fig. 12 CHP Power and HRSG Heating with Duct Burner Energy Boundary Diagram for Example 5

3.3 FUEL ENERGY SAVINGS

In addition to the PES formulation by EU Directive 2004/8/EC described in this section, electrical effectiveness provides a reasonable metric for CHP system comparison; however, it alone cannot provide a measure of fuel savings or emissions effects compared to separate, conventional generation of electric and thermal energy requirements. Understanding fuel savings or emissions effects requires further assumptions about the conventional, or reference, systems. Reference baselines for separate thermal heating are as previously developed. The reference baseline for separate electric generation is a conventional power plant's **electric generation efficiency** ψ. Typical values for ψ are listed in Table 5.

Fuel energy savings $\theta_{savings}$ then reflects fuel savings associated with generating the CHP system power and thermal output through CHP Q_{fuel} compared to using separate heating and electric power sources $\text{FUEL}_{reference}$:

Separate electricity Separate thermal heating

Table 3 Summary of Results from Examples 1 to 5

Example	System	η_E	η_O	ε_{EE}
1	Separate boiler and generator	0.25	0.46	0.25
2	Combined heat (hot water) and power	0.25	0.75	0.67
3	Combined heat (direct) and power	0.25	0.94	0.80
4	Heating (CT without cofired duct burner)	0.25	0.68	0.54
5	Heating (CT with cofired duct burner)	0.25	0.78	0.71

Table 4 Summary of Results Assuming 33% Efficient Combustion Turbine

Example	System	η_E	η_O	ε_{EE}
1	Separate boiler and generator	0.33	0.51	0.33
2	Combined heat (hot water) and power	0.33	0.87	1.00
3	Combined heat (direct) and power	0.33	0.95	1.40
4	Heating (CT without cofired duct burner)	0.33	0.72	0.64
5	Heating (CT with cofired duct burner)	0.33	0.67	0.47

Table 5 Typical ψ Values

Electric Generation Source	Generator η LHV	Generator η HHV	T&D Losses*	ψ
EIA average national grid	—	—	—	0.32*
High-efficiency combined cycle combustion turbine (CT)	0.600	0.540	0.050	0.49
Simple-cycle CT	0.380	0.340	0.068	0.27

*Calculated from DOE/EIA (2005).

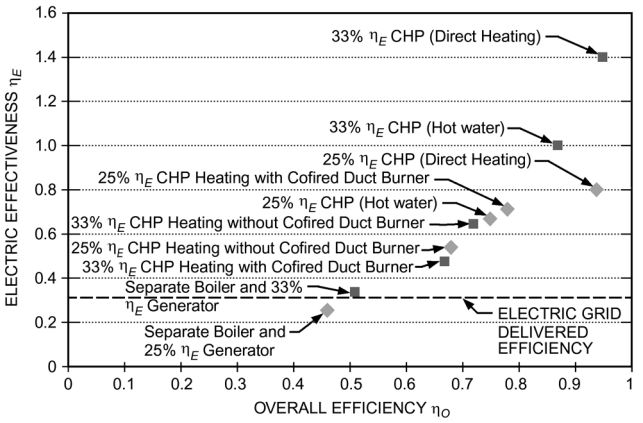


Fig. 13 Electric Effectiveness η_E Versus Overall Efficiency η_O

$$\text{FUEL}_{reference} = \left\{ \frac{W_E}{\psi} \right\} + \left\{ \frac{\sum Q_{TH}}{\text{HEAT}_{\alpha}} \right\}$$

$$\theta_{savings} = \frac{\text{FUEL}_{reference} - Q_{fuel}}{\text{FUEL}_{reference}}$$

Calculations using the system in Example 2 show a projected fuel savings of 29%, based on operation at the system design point:

$$\text{FUEL}_{reference} = \left\{ \frac{40}{0.32} \right\}_{\text{Electricity}} + \left\{ \frac{80}{0.80} \right\}_{\text{Thermal heating}} = 225$$

$$\theta_{savings} = \frac{225 - 160}{225} = 0.289$$

Note the rated design point, to show the utility of the approach in comparing equipment performance on a consistent basis (i.e., for program management and performance metrics). The same methodology could be applied to different design points (e.g., part load, different ambient temperatures) as long as system outputs and fuel inputs are all determined on a consistent basis (e.g., power output, fuel input, thermal output, and recovery all estimated based on 38°C ambient temperature and 300 m altitude). Reference system performance should also be considered on the same basis (e.g., it would not be fair to compare CHP electric effectiveness or fuel savings as calculated on a 38°C day to combined cycle efficiencies calculated at ISO conditions). Similarly, the methodology could be applied to actual application performance if system outputs and utilization are considered on a consistent basis (e.g., evaluating actual system power output, fuel input, and thermal energy used over some specified time period).

Fuel savings from the same direct heating and power CHP system as in Example 3.

$$\text{FUEL}_{reference} = \left\{ \frac{40}{0.32} \right\}_{\text{Electricity}} + \left\{ \frac{110}{1.0} \right\}_{\text{Thermal heating}} = 235$$

$$\theta_{savings} = \frac{235 - 160}{235} = 0.32$$

Applying the same process for the 25% power generator CHP systems (Examples 1 to 5) and using each of the three referenced electric comparisons gives the results presented in Table 6. Table 7 presents results obtained if a 33% generator is assumed.

EU Directive 2004/8/EC goes one step further in identifying the useful work potential difference between electrical and thermal energy and provides a fuel savings metric **PES (primary energy savings)** percentage:

Table 6 Summary of Fuel Energy Savings for 25% Power Generator in Examples 1 to 5

Example	CHP System	Simple Cycle Peaker	Grid Average	Adv. Combined Cycle
1	Separate boiler and generator	0.00	0.00	0.00
2	Combined heat (hot water) and power	0.35	0.29	0.12
3	Combined heat (direct) and power	0.38	0.32	0.17
4	Heating (CT without cofired duct burner)	0.32	0.24	0.05
5	Heating (CT with cofired duct burner)	0.24	0.19	0.08

$$\text{PES} = \left(1 - \frac{1}{\frac{\eta_E}{\text{Ref}\eta_E} + \frac{\eta_{TH}}{\text{Ref}\eta_{TH}}} \right) \times 100$$

$$= \left[1 - \frac{1}{\eta_E \left(\frac{1}{\text{Ref}\eta_E} + \frac{1}{C\text{Ref}\eta_{TH}} \right)} \right] \times 100$$

where

$$C = \frac{Q_E}{Q_{TH}} = \frac{\eta_E}{\eta_{TH}}$$

In practice, C varies between 0.6 and 1.5.

$$\eta_{TH} = \frac{\sum Q_{TH}}{Q_{fuel}}$$

Example 6. Given a CHP system with the following partial efficiencies for a given set of conditions: $\eta_E = 0.40$, $\eta_{TH} = 0.50$, and $C = 0.40/0.50 = 0.8$. Let the reference values be $\text{Ref}\eta_E = 0.52$ and $\text{Ref}\eta_{TH} = 0.85$. Then,

$$\text{PES} = \left(1 - \frac{1}{\frac{0.40}{0.52} + \frac{0.50}{0.85}} \right) \times 100 = 26.3\%$$

Because $\eta_E + \eta_{TH} < 1$, the upper bound for a high-efficiency CHP is about 33%.

This result does not incorporate the exergetic advantages of CHP. The PES value increases sharply if the second law of thermodynamics is directly considered in the above example (Kilkis and Kilkis 2007). Although the PES equation does not directly factor in the second law of thermodynamics, it at least recognizes the quantitative difference between electric and heat by identifying the net thermal power output η_{TH}.

Note that elevation, environmental conditions (air humidity, temperature, pressure), and loads (full or partial) affect electrical and power efficiencies. Thus, the power to heat ratio C varies instantaneously, depending on the type of the CHP equipment. Therefore, PES, η_E, and η_{TH} are not fixed properties of a given CHP system.

4. FUEL-TO-POWER COMPONENTS

This section describes devices that convert fuel energy to useful power. These energy-conversion technologies provide an important by-product in useful thermal energy that, when harnessed, enables thermal-to-power and thermal-to-thermal devices to operate. These devices are combined with thermal-to-power and/or thermal-to-thermal devices to form CHP systems.

Table 7 Summary of Fuel Energy Savings for 33% Power Generator in Examples 1 to 5

Example	CHP System	Simple Cycle Peaker	Grid Average	Adv. Combined Cycle
1	Separate boiler and generator	0.00	0.00	0.00
2	Combined heat (hot water) and power	0.47	0.41	0.26
3	Combined heat (direct) and power	0.50	0.44	0.31
4	Heating (CT without cofired duct burner)	0.41	0.33	0.13
5	Heating (CT with cofired duct burner)	0.23	0.16	(0.01)

4.1 RECIPROCATING ENGINES

Types

Two primary reciprocating engine designs are relevant to stationary power generation applications: the spark ignition (SI) Otto-cycle engine and the compression ignition diesel-cycle engine. The essential mechanical components of Otto-cycle and diesel-cycle engines are the same. Both have cylindrical combustion chambers, in which closely fitting pistons travel the length of the cylinders. The pistons are connected to a crankshaft by connecting rods that transform the linear motion of the pistons into the rotary motion of the crankshaft. Most engines have multiple cylinders that power a single crankshaft.

The primary difference between the Otto and diesel cycles is the method of igniting the fuel. Otto-cycle engines use a spark plug to ignite the premixed air-fuel mixture after it is introduced into the cylinder. Diesel-cycle engines compress the air introduced into the cylinder, raising its temperature above the auto-ignition temperature of the fuel, which is then injected into the cylinder at high pressure.

Reciprocating engines are further categorized by crankshaft speed (rpm), operating cycle (2- or 4-stroke), and whether turbocharging is used. These engines also are categorized by their original design purpose: automotive, truck, industrial, locomotive, or marine. Engines intended for industrial use are four-stroke Otto-cycle engines, and are designed for durability and for a wide range of mechanical drive and electric power applications. Stationary engine sizes range from 20 kW to more than 16 MW, including industrialized truck engines in the 200 to 600 kW range and industrially applied marine and locomotive engines up to 16 MW. Marine engines (two-stroke diesels) are available in capacities over 80,000 kW.

Both the spark-ignition and the diesel four-stroke engines, most prevalent in stationary power generation applications, complete a power cycle involving the following four piston strokes for each power stroke:

Intake stroke—Piston travels from top dead center (the highest position in the cylinder) to bottom dead center (the lowest position in the cylinder) and draws fresh air into the cylinder during the stroke. The intake valve is kept open during this stroke.

Compression stroke—Piston travels from the cylinder bottom to the top with all valves closed. As the air is compressed, its temperature increases. Shortly before the end of the stroke, a measured quantity of diesel fuel is injected into the cylinder. Fuel combustion begins just before the piston reaches top dead center.

Power stroke—Burning gases exert pressure on the piston, pushing it to bottom dead center. All valves are closed until shortly before the end of the stroke, when the exhaust valves are opened.

Exhaust stroke—Piston returns to top dead center, venting products of combustion from the cylinder through the exhaust valves.

The range of medium- and high-speed industrial engines and low-speed marine diesel reciprocating engines are listed in Table 8 by type, fuel, and speed.

Performance Characteristics

Important performance characteristics of an engine include its power rating, fuel consumption, and thermal output. Manufacturers base their engine ratings on the engine duty: prime power (continuous duty), standby operations, and peak load shaving. Because a CHP system is most cost-effective when operating at its base load, the rating at prime power (i.e., when the engine is the primary source of power) is usually of greatest interest. This rating is based on providing extended operating life with minimum maintenance. When used for standby, the engine produces continuously (24 h/day) for the length of the primary source outage. Peak power implies an operation level for only a few hours per day to meet peak demand in excess of the prime power capability.

Many manufacturers rate engine capacities according to ISO *Standard* 3046-1, which specifies that continuous net brake power under standard reference conditions (total barometric pressure 100 kPa, corresponding to approximately 100 m above sea level, air temperature 25°C, and relative humidity 30%) can be exceeded by 10% for 1 h, with or without interruptions, within a period of 12 h of operation. ISO *Standard* 3046-1 defines prime power as power available for continuous operation under varying load factors and 10% overload as previously described. The standard defines standby power as power available for operation under normal varying load factors, not overloadable (for applications normally designed to require a maximum of 300 h of service per year).

However, the basis of the manufacturer's ratings (ambient temperature, altitude, and atmospheric pressure of the test conditions) must be known to determine the engine rating at site conditions. Various derating factors are used. Naturally aspirated engine output typically decreases 3% for each 300 m increase in altitude, whereas turbocharged engines lose 2% per 300 m. Power output decreases by about 0.18% per kelvin increase in ambient temperature, so it is important to avoid using heated air for combustion. In addition, an engine must be derated for fuels with a heating value significantly greater than the base specified by the manufacturer. For CHP applications, natural gas is the baseline fuel, although use of propane, landfill gas, digester gas, and biomass is increasing.

Natural gas spark-ignition engines are typically less efficient than diesel engines because of their lower compression ratios. However, large, high-performance lean-burn engine efficiencies approach those of diesel engines of the same size. Natural gas engine efficiencies range from about 25% HHV (28% LHV) for engines smaller than 50 kW, to 37% HHV (41% LHV) for larger, high-performance, lean-burn engines (DOE 2003).

Power rating is determined by a number of engine design characteristics, the most important of which is displacement; other factors include rotational speed, method of ignition, compression ratio, aspiration, cooling system, jacket water temperature, and intercooler temperature. Most engine designs are offered in a range of displacements achieved by different bore and stroke, but with the same number of cylinders in each case. Many larger engine designs retain the same basic configuration, and displacement increases are achieved by simply lengthening the block and adding more cylinders.

Figure 14 shows the efficiency of typical SI natural gas engine/shaft power operating at the prime power rating (HHV).

Table 8 Reciprocating Engine Types by Speed (AvailableMW Ratings)

Speed Classification	Engine Speed, rpm	Stoichiometric/Rich Burn, Spark Ignition (Natural Gas)	Lean Burn, Spark Ignition (Natural Gas)	Dual Fuel	Diesel
High	1000 to 3600	0.01 to 1.5 MW	0.15 to 3.0 MW	1.0 to 3.5 MW	0.01 to 3.5 MW
Medium	275 to 1000	None	1.0 to 16.0 MW	1.0 to 25 MW	0.5 to 35 MW
Low	60 to 275	None	None	2.0 to 65 MW	2.0 to 80 MW

Source: Adapted from EPA (2002).

Fuel consumption is the greatest contributor to operating cost and should be carefully considered during planning and design of a CHP system. It is influenced by combustion cycle, speed, compression ratio, and type of aspiration. It is often expressed in terms of power (kW) for natural gas engines, but for purposes of comparison, it may be expressed as a ratio of power or energy input per unit of output, such as W/W, J/J, or kJ/kWh. The latter two ratios are sometimes called the **heat rate** (of an engine). The heat rate is the heat input per unit of power output based on either the low or high heating value of the fuel.

Heat rates of several SI engines are shown in Figure 15. The heat rate for an engine of a given size is affected by design and operating factors other than displacement. The most efficient (lowest heat rate) of these engines is naturally aspirated and achieves its increased performance because of the slightly higher compression ratio.

The **thermal-to-electric ratio** is a measure of the useful thermal output for the electrical power being generated. For most reciprocating engines, the recoverable thermal energy is that of the exhaust and jacket. Figure 16 shows the thermal-to-electric ratio of the SI engines.

Ideally, a CHP plant should operate at full output to achieve maximum cost effectiveness. In plants that must operate at part load some of the time, part-load fuel consumption and thermal output are important factors that must be considered in the overall economics of the CHP plant. Figures 17 and 18 show the part-load heat rate and thermal-to-electric ratio as a function of load for 1430, 425, and 85 kW engines.

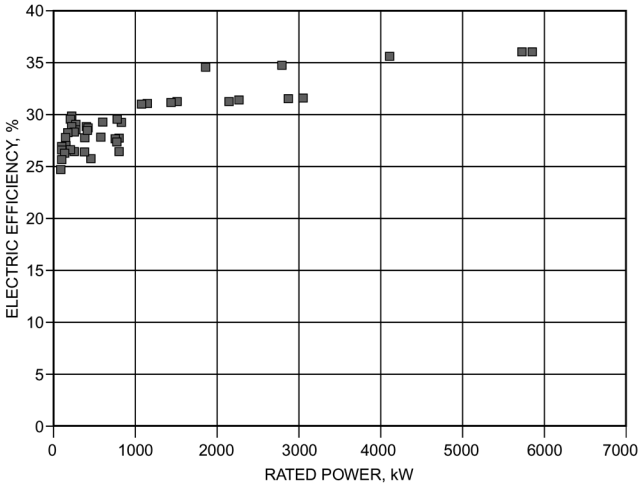


Fig. 14 Efficiency (HHV) of Spark Ignition Engines

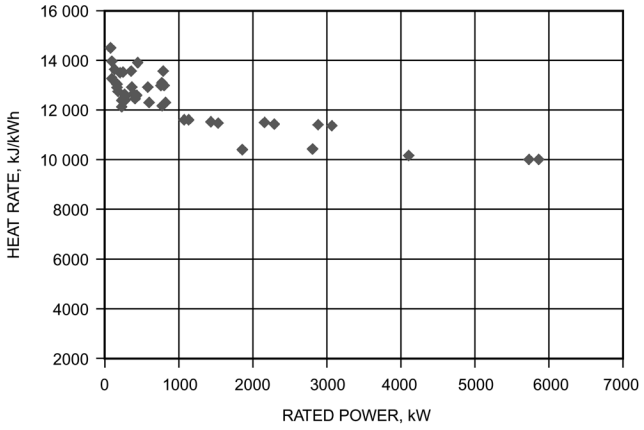


Fig. 15 Heat Rate (HHV) of Spark Ignition Engines

Fuels and Fuel Systems

Fuel Selection. Fuel specifications, grade, and characteristics have a marked effect on engine performance. Fuel standards for

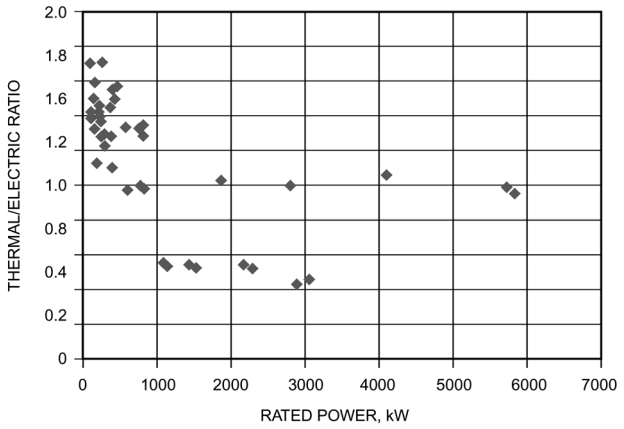


Fig. 16 Thermal-to-Electric Ratio of Spark Ignition Engines (Jacket and Exhaust Energy)

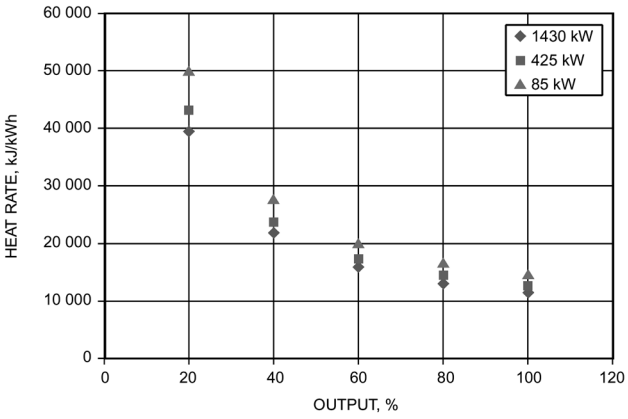


Fig. 17 Part-Load Heat Rate (HHV) of 1430, 425, and 85 kW Gas Engines

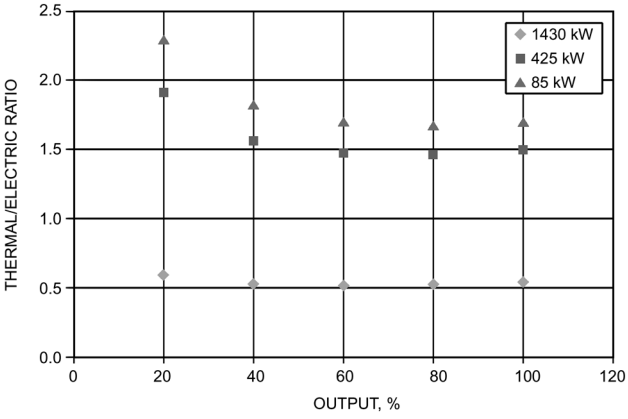


Fig. 18 Part-Load Thermal-to-Electric Ratio of 1430, 425, and 85 kW Gas Engines

internal combustion engines are designated by the American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM).

Engines may be fueled with a wide variety of fuels and fuel blends, including natural gas, propane, landfill gas, digester gas, bio-oils, biodisel, diesel, or heavier oils. A small amount of diesel oil is used as the compression ignition agent when dual-fuel engines are operated in gaseous-fuel mode.

Gasoline engines are generally not used because of fuel storage hazards, fuel cost, and the higher maintenance required because of deposits of combustion products on internal parts.

Methane-rich gas from wastewater treatment or anaerobic digesters can be used as a fuel for both engines and other heating services. The fuel must be dried and cleaned before injection into engines. Because methane-rich gas has a lower heat content (approximately 22 to 26 MJ/m), it is sometimes mixed with natural gas. The large amount of hydrogen sulfide in the fuel requires using special materials, such as aluminum in the bearings and bushings and low-friction plastic in the O rings and gaskets.

The final choice of fuel should be based on fuel availability, cost, storage requirements, emissions requirements, and fuel rate. Except for gasoline engines, maintenance costs tend to be similar for all engines.

Fuel Heating Value. Fuel consumption data may be reported in terms of either high heating value (HHV) or low heating value (LHV). HHV is used by the gas utility industry and is the basis for evaluating most gaseous fuel. The cost of natural gas is based on HHV. Most natural gases have an LHV/HHV factor of 0.9 to 0.95, ranging from 0.87 for hydrogen to 1.0 for carbon monoxide. For fuel oils, LHV/HHV ranges from 0.96 (heavy oils) to 0.93 (light oils). The HHV is customarily used for oil (including pilot oil in dual-fuel engines).

Fuel Oil Systems. Storage, handling, and cleaning of liquid fuels are covered in Chapter 31. Most oil-fueled CHP is with No. 2 diesel fuel, which is much simpler to handle than the heavier grades. Residual oil is used only for large industrial projects with low-speed engines.

The fuel injection system is the heart of the diesel cycle. Performance functions are as follows:

- Meter a constant quantity to each cylinder at any load during each combustion cycle.
- Inject fuel (1) with a precise and rapid beginning and ending at the correct timing point in each cycle and (2) at a rate needed for controlled combustion and pressure rise.
- Atomize the fuel and distribute it evenly through the air in the combustion chamber.

Atomization can be by high-pressure air injection and mechanical injection. Older systems used air injection until satisfactory mechanical injection systems were developed that avoid the high initial cost and parasitic operating cost of the air compressor.

Previously, mechanical injection pressurized a header to provide a common fuel pressure near 35 MPa. A camshaft opened a spray nozzle in each cylinder, with the length of spray time proportioned to the load through a governor or throttle control. With this system, a leaky valve allowed a steady drip into the cylinder throughout the cycle, which caused poor fuel economy and smoking.

Currently, three injection designs are used:

- Individual plunger pumps for each cylinder, with controlled bypass, controlled suction, variable-suction orifice, variable stroke, or port-and-helix metering
- Common high-pressure metering pump with a separate distribution line to each cylinder that delivers fuel to each cylinder in firing-order sequence
- Common low-pressure metering pump and distributor with a mechanically operated, high-pressure pump and nozzle at each cylinder (excess fuel is recirculated back to the tank through a cooler to remove heat)

Spark Ignition Gas Systems. Fuels vary widely in composition and cleanliness, from pipeline natural gas requiring only a meter, a pressure regulating valve, and safety devices to those from wastewater or biomass, which may also require scrubbers and holding tanks. Gas system accessories include the following.

Line-Type Gas Pressure Regulators. Turbocharged (and aftercooled) engines, as well as many naturally aspirated units, are equipped with line regulators designed to control gas pressure to the engine regulator, as shown in Table 9. The same regulators (both line and engine) used on naturally aspirated gas engines may be used on turbocharged equipment.

Line-type gas pressure regulators are commonly called service regulators (and field regulators). They are usually located just upstream of the engine regulator to ensure that the required pressure range exists at the inlet to the engine regulator. A remote location is sometimes specified; consult the authorities having jurisdiction. Although this intermediate regulation does not constitute a safety device, it does allow initial regulation (by the gas utility at the meter inlet) at a higher outlet pressure, thus allowing an extra cushion of gas between the line regulator and meter for both full gas flow at engine start-ups and delivery to any future branches from the same supply line. The engine manufacturer specifies the size, type, orifice size, and other regulator characteristics based on the anticipated gas pressure range.

Engine-Type Gas Pressure Regulators. This engine-mounted pressure regulator, also called a *carburetor regulator* (and sometimes a *secondary* or *B regulator*), controls fuel pressure to the carburetor. Regulator construction may vary with fuel used. The unit is similar to a zero governor.

Air/Fuel Control. The flow of air/fuel mixtures must be controlled in definite ratios under all load and speed conditions required of engines.

Air/Fuel Ratios. High-rated, naturally aspirated, spark ignition engines require closely controlled air/fuel ratios. Excessively lean mixtures cause excessive lubricating oil consumption and engine overheating. Engines using pilot oil ignition can run at rates above 0.13 ppm/kW without misfiring. Air rates may vary with changes in compression ratio, valve timing, and ambient conditions.

Carburetors. In these venturi devices, the airflow mixture is controlled by a governor-actuated butterfly valve. This air/fuel control has no moving parts other than the butterfly valve. The motivating force in naturally aspirated engines is the vacuum created by the intake strokes of the pistons. Turbocharged engines, on the other hand, supply the additional energy as pressurized air and pressurized fuel.

Fuel Injectors. These electromechanical devices, which are essentially solenoids through which fuel is metered, spray atomized fuel directly into the combustion chamber. Electric current applied to the injector coil creates a magnetic field, which causes the armature to move upward and unseats a spring-loaded ball or pintle valve. Pressurized fuel can then flow out of the injector nozzle in a cone-

Table 9 Line Regulator Pressures

Line Regulator	Turbocharged Engine[a]	Naturally Aspirated Engine[a]
Inlet	100 to 140 kPa (gage)	14 to 210 kPa (gage)
Outlet[b]	80 to 100 kPa (gage)[c]	1.7 to 2.5 kPa (gage)

[a]Overall ranges, not variation for individual installations.
[b]Also inlet to engine regulator.
[c]Turbocharger boost plus 1.7 to 2.5 kPa.

shaped pattern (caused by the pintle valve's shape). When the injector is deenergized, the ball or valve reseats itself, stopping fuel flow.

Ignition. An electrical system or pilot oil ignition may be used. Electrical systems are either low-tension (make-and-break) or high-tension (jump spark). Systems with breakerless ignition distribution are also used.

Dual-Fuel. Engines using gas with pilot oil for ignition (but that can also operate on 100% diesel) are commonly classified as *dual-fuel engines*. Dual-fuel engines operate either on full oil or on gas and pilot oil, with automatic online switchover when appropriate. In sewage gas systems, a blend with natural gas may be used to maintain a minimum LHV or to satisfy fuel demand when sewage gas production is short.

Combustion Air

All internal combustion engines require clean, cool air for optimum performance. High humidity does not hurt performance, and may even help by slowing combustion and reducing cylinder pressure and temperature. Provisions must be made to silence air noise and provide adequate air for combustion.

Smaller engines generally use engine-mounted impingement filters, often designed for some silencing, whereas larger engines commonly use a cyclone filter or various oil-bath filters. Selection considerations are (1) efficiency or dirt removal capacity; (2) airflow resistance (high intake pressure drop affects performance); (3) ease, frequency, and cost of cleaning or replacement; and (4) first cost. Many of the filter types and media common in HVAC systems are used, but they are designed specifically for engine use. Air piping is designed for low pressure drop (more important for naturally aspirated than for supercharged engines) to maintain high engine performance. For engine intakes, conventional velocities range from 15 to 35 m/s, governed by the engine manufacturer's recommended maximum pressure drop of approximately 1.5 kPa. Evaporative coolers are sometimes used to cool the air before it enters the engine intake.

Essentially, all modern industrial engines above 300 kW are turbocharged to achieve higher power densities. A turbocharger is basically a turbine-driven intake air compressor; hot, high-velocity exhaust gases leaving the engine cylinders power the turbine. Very large engines typically are equipped with two large or four small turbochargers. On a carbureted engine, turbocharging forces more air and fuel into the cylinders, increasing engine output. On a fuel-injected engine, the mass of fuel injected must be increased in proportion to the increased air input. Turbocharging normally increases cylinder pressure and temperature, increasing the tendency for detonation for both spark ignition and dual-fuel engines and requiring a careful balance between compression ratio and turbocharger boost level. Turbochargers normally boost inlet air pressure by a factor of 3 to 4. A wide range of turbocharger designs and models is used. Aftercoolers or intercoolers are often used to cool combustion air exiting the turbocharger compressor, to keep the temperature of air to the engine under a specified limit and to increase the air density. A recirculated water coolant recovery system is used for aftercooling.

Table 10 Ventilation Air for Engine Equipment Rooms

Room Air Temperature Rise,[a] °C	Airflow, $m^3/(kW \cdot s)$		
	Muffler and Exhaust Pipe[b]	Muffler and Exhaust Pipe[c]	Air- or Radiator-Cooled Engine[d]
5	0.10	0.19	0.38
10	0.050	0.10	0.20
15	0.035	0.065	0.13

[a]Exhaust minus inlet.
[b]Insulated or enclosed in ventilated duct.
[c]Not insulated.
[d]Heat discharged in engine room.

The following factors apply to combustion air requirements:

- Avoid heated air because power output varies by $(T_r/T_a)^{0.5}$, where T_r is the temperature at which the engine is rated and T_a is engine air intake temperature, both in kelvins.
- Locate the intake away from contaminated air sources.
- Install properly sized air cleaners that can be readily inspected and maintained (pressure drop indicators are available). Air cleaners minimize cylinder wear and piston ring fouling. About 90% of valve, piston ring, and cylinder wall wear is the result of dust. Both dry and wet cleaners are used. If wet cleaners are undersized, oil carryover may reduce filter life. Filters may also serve as flame arresters.
- Engine room air-handling systems may include supply and exhaust fans, louvers, shutters, bird screens, and air filters. The maximum total static pressure opposing the fan should be 0.09 kPa. Table 10 gives sample ventilation air requirements.
- On large engines, intake air is taken from outside the building, enabling a reduction in the building HVAC system. An intake silencer is typically used to eliminate engine noise.

Lubricating Systems

All engines use the lubricating system to remove some heat from the machine. Some configurations cool only the piston skirt with oil; other designs remove more engine heat with the lubricating system. The engine's operating temperature may be significant in determining the proportion of engine heat removed by the lubricant. Between 5 and 10% of the total fuel input is converted to heat that must be extracted from the lubricating oil; this may warrant using oil coolant at temperatures high enough to allow economic use in a process such as domestic water heating.

Radiator-cooled units generally use the same fluid to cool the engine water jacket and the lubricant; thus, the temperature difference between oil and jacket coolant is not significant. If oil temperature rises in one area (e.g., around the piston skirts), heat may be transferred to other engine oil passages and then removed by the jacket coolant. When engine jacket temperatures are much higher than lubricant temperatures, the reverse process occurs, and the oil removes heat from the engine oil passages.

Determining the lubricant cooling effect is necessary in the design of heat exchangers and coolant systems, which is typically performed by the engine manufacturer. Heat is dissipated to the lubricant in a four-cycle engine with a high-temperature (105 to 120°C) jacket water coolant at a rate of about 90 to 105 W/kW output; oil heat is rejected in the same engine at 40 to 50 W/kW. However, this engine uses more moderate (82°C) coolant temperatures for both lubricating oil and engine jacket.

The characteristics of each lubricant, engine, and application are different, and only periodic laboratory analysis of oil samples can establish optimum lubricant service periods. Consider the following factors in selecting an engine:

- High-quality lubricating oils are generally required for operation between 70 and 93°C, with longer oil life expected at lower temperatures. Moisture may condense in the crankcase if the oil is too cool, which reduces the useful life of the oil.
- Contact with copper can cause oil breakdown, so avoid using copper piping in oil-side surfaces in oil coolers and heat exchangers.
- A full-flow filter provides better security against oil contamination than one that filters only a portion of circulated lubricating oil and bypasses the rest.

Starting Systems

Larger engines are frequently started with compressed air, either by direct cylinder injection or by air-driven motors. In large plants, one of the smallest multiple compressors is usually engine-driven for a "black start." The same procedure is used for fuel oil systems

when the main storage tank cannot gravity-feed the day tank. However, storage tanks must have the capacity for several starting procedures on any one engine, in case of repeated failure to start.

Another start-up concept eliminates all auxiliary engine drives and powers the motor-driven auxiliaries directly through a segregated circuit served by a separate, smaller engine-driven emergency generator. This circuit can be sized for the black-start power and control requirements as well as for emergency lighting and receptacles for power tools and welding devices. For a black start, or after any major damage causing a plant failure, this circuit can be used for repairs at the plant and at other buildings in the complex.

Cooling Systems

Jacket Water Systems. Circulating water and oil systems must be kept clean because the internal coolant passages of the engine are not readily accessible for service. Installation of piping, heat exchangers, valves, and accessories must include provisions for internally cleaning these circuits before they are placed in service and, when possible, for maintenance access afterwards.

Coolant fluids must be noncorrosive and free from salts, minerals, or chemical additives that can deposit on hot engine surfaces or form sludge in relatively inactive fluid passages. Generally, engines cannot be drained and flushed effectively without major disassembly, making any chemical treatment of the coolant fluid that can produce sediment or sludge undesirable.

An initial step toward maintaining clean coolant surfaces is to limit fresh water makeup. The coolant system should be tight and leak-free. Softened or mineral-free water is effective for initial fill and makeup. Forced-circulation hot-water systems may require only minor corrosion-inhibiting additives to ensure long, trouble-free service. This feature is one of the major benefits of hot-water heat recovery systems.

Water-Cooled Engines. Heat in the engine coolant should be removed by heat exchange to a separate water system. Recirculated water can then be cooled in open-circuit cooling towers, where water is added to make up for evaporation. Closed-circuit coolant of all types (e.g., for closed-circuit evaporative coolers, radiators, or engine-side circuits of shell-and-tube heat exchangers) should be treated with a rust inhibitor and/or antifreeze to protect the engine jacket. Because engine coolant is best kept in a protected closed loop, it is usually circulated on the shell side of an exchanger. A minimum fouling factor of 0.002 should be assigned to the tube side.

Jacket water outlet and inlet temperature ranges of 79 to 88°C and 74 to 79°C, respectively, are generally recommended, except when the engines are used with a heat recovery system. These temperatures are maintained by one or more thermostats that bypass water as required. A 5 to 8 K temperature rise is usually accompanied by a circulating water rate of about 42 to 59 ML/s per engine kilowatt.

Size water piping according to the engine manufacturer's recommendations, avoiding restrictions in the water pump inlet line. Piping must not be connected rigidly to the engine. Provide shutoffs to facilitate maintenance.

If the cost of pumping water at conventional jacket water temperature can be absorbed in the external system, a hot-water system is preferred. However, the cooling tower must be sized for the full jacket heat rejection if there are periods when no load is available to absorb it (see Chapter 40 for information on cooling tower design). Most engines are designed for forced circulation of the coolant.

Where several engines are used in one process, independent coolant systems for each machine can be used to avoid complete plant shutdown from a common coolant system component failure. This independence can be a disadvantage because unused engines are not maintained at operating temperature, as they are when all units are in a common circulating system. If idle machine temperature drops below combustion products' dew point, corrosive condensate may form in the exhaust gas passages each time the idle machine is started.

When substantial water volume and machinery mass must be heated to operating temperature, the condensate volume is quite significant and must be drained. Some contaminants will get into the lubricant and reduce the service life. If the machinery gets very cold, it may be difficult to start. Units that are started and stopped frequently require an off-cycle heating sequence to lessen exposure to corrosion.

Still another concept for avoiding a total plant shutdown, and minimizing the risk of any single-engine shutdown, requires the following arrangement:

- A common, interconnected jacket water piping system for all the engines.
- An extra standby device for all auxiliaries (e.g., pumps, heat exchangers). Valves must be installed to isolate any auxiliary that fails or is out for preventive maintenance, to allow continued operation.
- Header isolation valves to allow continued plant operation while any section of the common piping is serviced or repaired.

This common piping arrangement permits continuous full-load plant operation if any one auxiliary suffers an outage or needs maintenance; no more than one engine in the battery can have a forced outage if the headers suffer a problem. On the other hand, independent, dedicated auxiliaries for each engine can force an engine outage whenever an auxiliary is down, unless each such auxiliary is provided with a standby, which is not a practical option. Furthermore, using common headers avoids the possibility of a second engine outage when any of the second engine's support components fails while the first is out for major repair. It also allows a warm start of any engine by circulation of a moderate flow of the hot jacket water through any idle engine.

Exhaust Systems

Engine exhaust must be safely conveyed from the engine through piping and any auxiliary equipment to the atmosphere at an allowable pressure drop and noise level. Allowable back pressures, which vary with engine design, range from 0.5 to 6 kPa. For low-speed engines, this limit is typically 1.5 kPa; for high-speed engines, it is typically 3 kPa. Adverse effects of excessive pressure drops include power loss, poor fuel economy, and excessive valve temperatures, all of which result in shortened service life and jacket water overheating.

General installation recommendations include the following:

- Install a high-temperature, flexible connection between the engine and exhaust piping. Exhaust gas temperature does not normally exceed 650°C, but may reach 760°C for short periods. An appropriate stainless steel connector may be used.
- Adequately support the exhaust system downstream from the connector. At maximum operating temperature, no weight should be exerted on the engine or its exhaust outlet.
- Minimize the distance between the silencer and engine.
- Use a 30 to 45° tailpipe angle to reduce turbulence.
- Specify tailpipe length (in the absence of other criteria) in odd multiples of $16.8(T_e^{0.5}/P)$, where T_e is the temperature of the exhaust gas (kelvins), and P is exhaust frequency (pulses per second). The value of P is calculated as follows:

  P = rpm/120 = (rev/s)/2 for four-stroke engines
  P = rpm/60 = rev/s for two-stroke engines

  Note that for V-engines with two exhaust manifolds, rpm or rev/s equals engine speed.

- A second, less desirable, exhaust arrangement is a Y-connection with branches entering the single pipe at about a 60° angle; never

use a T-connection, because pulses of one branch will interfere with pulses from the other.
- Use an engine-to-silencer pipe length that is 25% of the tailpipe length.
- Install a separate exhaust for each engine to reduce the possibility of condensation in an engine that is not running.
- Install individual silencers to reduce condensation resulting from an idle engine.
- Limit heat radiation from exhaust piping with a ventilated sleeve around the pipe or with high-temperature insulation.
- Use large enough fittings to minimize pressure drop.
- Allow for thermal expansion in exhaust piping, which is about 7.5 mm per metre of length.
- Specify muffler pressure drops to be within the back-pressure limits of the engine.
- Do not connect the engine exhaust pipe to a chimney that serves natural-draft gas appliances.
- Slope exhaust away from the engine to prevent condensate backflow. Drain plugs in silencers and drip legs in long, vertical exhaust runs may also be required. Raincaps may prevent entrance of moisture but might add back pressure and prevent adequate upward ejection velocity.

Proper effluent discharge and weather protection can be maintained in continuously operated systems by maintaining sufficient discharge velocity (over 12.7 m/s) through a straight stack; in intermittently operated systems, protection can be maintained by installing drain-type stacks.

Drain-Type Stack. Drain-type stacks effectively eliminate rainfall entry into a vertical stack terminal without destroying the upward ejection velocity as a rain cap does. This design places a stack head, rather than a stack cap, over the discharge stack. The height of the upper section is important for adequate rain protection, just as the height of the stack is important for adequate dispersal of effluent. Stack height should be great enough to discharge above the building eddy zone (see Chapter 46 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information on exhaust stack design). Bolts for inner stack fastening should be soldered, welded, or brazed, depending on the tack material.

Powerhouse Stack. In this design, a fan discharge intersects the stack at a 45° angle. A drain lip and drain are added in the fume discharge version.

Offset Design. This design is recommended for round ductwork and can be used with sheet metal or glass-fiber-reinforced polyester ductwork.

The exhaust pipe may be routed between an interior engine installation and a roof-mounted muffler through (1) an existing unused flue or one serving power-vented gas appliances only (this should not be used if exhaust gases may be returned to the interior); (2) an exterior fireproof wall with provision for condensate drip to the vertical run; or (3) the roof, provided that a galvanized thimble with flanges and an annular clearance of 100 to 125 mm is used. Sufficient clearance is required between the flue terminal and rain cap on the pipe to allow flue venting. A clearance of 760 mm between the muffler and roof is common. Vent passages and chimneys should be checked for resonance.

When interior mufflers must be used, minimize the distance between the muffler and engine, and insulate inside the muffler portion of the flue. Flue runs more than 7.5 m may require power venting, but vertical flues help to overcome the pressure drop (natural draft).

The following design and installation features should be used for flexible connections:

- Material: Convoluted steel (Grade 321 stainless steel) is favored for interior installation.

Table 11 Exhaust Pipe Diameter*

Output Power, kW	Minimum Pipe Diameter, mm			
	Equivalent Length of Exhaust Pipe			
	7.5 m	15 m	22.5 m	30 m
19	75	100	100	100
37	100	100	125	125
56	100	125	125	125
75	125	125	150	150
150	150	150	175	175
300	175	200	225	225
450	225	225	250	275
600	275	275	275	300
750	300	300	300	325
1120	325	325	375	375
1500	375	400	425	425

*Minimum exhaust pipe diameter to limit engine exhaust back pressure to 2 kPa (gage).

- Location: Principal imposed motion (vibration) should be at right angles to the connector axis.
- Assembly: The connector (not an expansion joint) should not be stretched or compressed; it should be secured without bends, offsets, or twisting (using float flanges is recommended).
- Anchor: The exhaust pipe should be rigidly secured immediately downstream of the connector in line with the downstream pipe.
- Exhaust piping: Some alloys and standard steel alloy or steel pipe may be joined by fittings of malleable cast iron. Table 11 shows exhaust pipe sizes. The exhaust pipe should be at least as large as the engine exhaust connection. Stainless steel double-wall liners may be used.

Emissions

Exhaust emissions are the major environmental concern with reciprocating engines. The main pollutants are oxides of nitrogen (NO_x), carbon monoxide (CO), and volatile organic compounds (VOCs; unburned or partially burned nonmethane hydrocarbons). Other pollutants, such as oxides of sulfur (SO_x) and particulate matter (PM), depend on the fuel used. Emissions of sulfur compounds (particularly SO_2) are directly related to the fuel's sulfur content. Engines operating on natural gas or distillate oil, which has been desulfurized in the refinery, emit insignificant levels of SO_x. In general, SO_x emissions are an issue only in larger, lower-speed diesel engines firing heavy oils.

Particulate matter can be important for liquid-fueled engines. Ash and metallic additives in fuel and lubricating oil contribute to PM concentrations in exhaust.

NO_x emissions, usually the major concern with natural gas engines, are mostly a mixture of NO and NO_2. Measurements of NO_x are reported as parts per million by volume, in which both species count equally (e.g., ppmv at 15% O_2, dry). Other common units for reporting NO_x in reciprocating engines are specific output-based emission factors, such as g/(kW·h), or as total output rates, such as kg/h. Among the engine options without exhaust aftertreatment, lean-burn natural gas engines produce the lowest NO_x emissions; diesel-fueled engines produce the highest. In many localities, emissions pollutant reduction is mandatory. Three-way catalytic reduction is the general method for stoichiometric and rich-burn engines, and selective catalytic reduction (SCR) for lean-burn engines.

Instruments and Controls

Starting Systems. Start/stop control may include manual or automatic activation of the engine fuel supply, engine cranking cycle, and establishment of the engine heat removal circuits. Stop circuits always shut off the fuel supply, and, for spark ignition engines, the ignition system is generally grounded as a precaution against incomplete fuel valve closing.

Alarm and Shutdown Controls. The prime mover is protected from malfunction by alarms that warn of unusual conditions and by safety shutdown under unsafe conditions. The control system must protect against failure of (1) speed control (underspeed or overspeed), (2) lubrication (low oil pressure, high oil temperature), (3) heat removal (high coolant temperature or lack of coolant flow), (4) combustion process (fuel, ignition), (5) lubricating oil level, and (6) water level.

Controls for alarms preceding shutdown are provided as needed. Monitored alarms without shutdown include lubricating oil and fuel filter, lubricating oil temperature, manifold temperature, jacket water temperature, etc. Automatic start-up of the standby engine when an alarm/shutdown sequence is triggered is often provided.

Both a low-lubrication pressure switch and a high jacket water temperature cutout are standard for most gas engines. Other safety controls used include (1) an engine speed governor, (2) ignition current failure shutdown (battery-type ignition only), and (3) the safety devices associated with a driven machine. These devices shut down the engine to protect it against mechanical damage. They do not necessarily shut off the gas fuel supply unless they are specifically set to do so.

Governors. A governor senses speed (and sometimes load), either directly or indirectly, and acts by means of linkages to control the flow of gas and air through engine carburetors or other fuel-metering devices to maintain a desired speed. Speed control with electronic, hydraulic, or pneumatic governors extends engine life by minimizing forces on engine parts, allows automatic throttle response without operator attention, and prevents destructive overspeeding. A separate overspeed device, sometimes called an overspeed trip, prevents runaway in the event of a failure that disables the governor. Both constant and variable engine speed controls are available. For constant speed, the governor is set at a fixed position, which can be reset manually.

Gas Leakage Prevention. The first method of avoiding gas leakage caused by engine regulator failure is to install a solenoid shutdown valve with a positive cutoff either upstream or downstream of the engine regulator. The second method is a sealed combustion system that carries any leakage gas directly to the outdoors (i.e., all combustion air is ducted to the engine directly from the outdoors).

Noise and Vibration

Engine-driven machines installed indoors, even where the background noise level is high, usually require noise attenuation and isolation from adjoining areas. Air-cooled radiators, noise radiated from surroundings, and exhaust heat recovery boilers may also require silencing. Installations in more sensitive areas may be isolated, receive sound treatment, or both.

Because engine exhaust must be muffled to reduce ambient noise levels, most recovery units also act as silencers. Figure 19 shows a typical exhaust noise curve. Figure 20 shows typical attenuation curves for various silencers. Table 1 in Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* lists acceptable noise level criteria for various applications.

Basic attenuation includes (1) turning air intake and exhaust openings away (usually up) from the potential listener; (2) limiting blade-tip speed (if forced-draft air cooling is used) to 60 m/s for industrial applications, 50 m/s for commercial applications, and 40 m/s for critical locations; (3) acoustically treating the fan shroud and plenum between blades and coils; (4) isolating (or covering) moving parts, including the unit, from their shelter (where used); (5) properly selecting the gas meter and regulator(s) to prevent singing; and (6) adding sound traps or silencers on ventilation air intake, exhaust, or both.

Further attenuation means include (1) lining intake and exhaust manifolds with sound-absorbing materials; (2) mounting the unit, particularly a smaller engine, on vibration isolators, thereby reducing foundation vibration; (3) installing a barrier (often a concrete block enclosure) between the prime mover and the listener; (4) enclosing the unit with a cover of absorbing material; and (5) locating the unit in a building constructed of massive materials, paying particular attention to the acoustics of the ventilating system and doors.

Noise levels must meet legal requirements (see Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for details).

Foundations. Multicylinder, medium-speed engines may not require massive concrete foundations, although concrete offers advantages in cost and in maintaining alignment for some driven equipment. Fabricated steel bases are satisfactory for direct-coupled, self-contained units, such as electric sets. Steel bases mounted on steel spring or equal-vibration isolators are adequate and need no special foundation other than a floor designed to accommodate the weight. Concrete bases are also satisfactory for such units, if the bases are equally well isolated from the supporting floor or subfloor.

Glass-fiber blocks are effective as isolation material for concrete bases, which should be thick enough to prevent deflection. Excessively thick bases only increase subfloor or soil loading, and still should be supported by a concrete subfloor. In addition, some acceptable isolation material should be placed between the base and

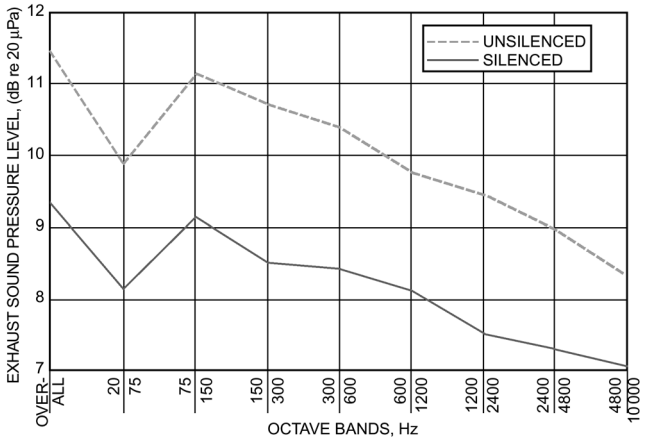


Fig. 19 Typical Reciprocating Engine Exhaust Noise Curves

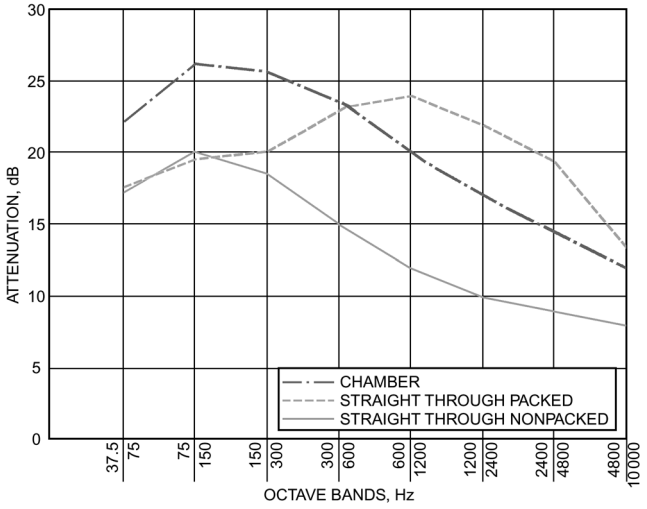


Fig. 20 Typical Attenuation Curves for Engine Silencers

the floor. To avoid vibration transmission, an engine base or foundation should never rest directly on natural rock formations. Under some conditions, such as shifting soil on which an outlying CHP plant might be built, a single, very thick concrete pad for all equipment and auxiliaries may be required to avoid a catastrophic shift between one device and another (see Chapters 49 and 56 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information on vibration isolation and seismic design, respectively).

Alignment and Couplings. Proper alignment of the prime mover to the driven device is necessary to prevent undue stresses to the shaft, coupling, and seals of the assembly. Installation instructions usually suggest that alignment of the assembly be performed and measured at maximum load condition and maximum heat input to the turbine or engine.

Torsional vibrations can be a major problem when matching these components, particularly when matching a reciprocating engine to any higher speed centrifugal device. The stiffness of a coupling and its dynamic response to small vibrations from an angular misalignment at critical speed(s) affect the natural frequencies in the assembly. Encotech (1992) describes how changing the coupling's mass, stiffness, or damping can alter the natural frequency during start-up, synchronization, or load change or when a natural frequency exists within the assembly's operating envelope. Proper grouting is needed to preserve the alignment.

Flexible Connections. Greater care is required in the design of piping connections to turbines and engines than for other HVAC equipment because the larger temperature spread causes greater expansion. (See Chapter 46 for further information on piping.)

Installation Ventilation Requirements

In addition to dissipating heat from the jacket water system, exhaust system, lubrication and piston cooling oil, turbocharger, and air intercooler, radiation and convection losses from the surfaces of the engine components and accessories and piping must be dissipated by ventilation. If the radiated heat is more than 8 to 10% of the fuel input, an air cooler may be required. In some cases, rejected heat can be productively applied as tempered makeup air in an adjacent space, with consideration given to life/fire safety requirements, but in most instances it is simply vented.

This heat must be removed to maintain acceptable working conditions and to avoid overloading electrical systems with high ambient conditions. Heat can be removed by outdoor air ventilation systems that include dampers and fans and thermostatic controls regulated to prevent overheating or excessively low temperatures in extreme weather. The manner and amount of heat rejection vary with the type, size, and make of engine and the extent of engine loading.

An **air-cooled engine** installation includes the following:

- An outdoor air entrance at least as large as the radiator face and 25 to 50% larger if protective louvers impede airflow.
- Auxiliary means (e.g., a hydraulic, pneumatic, or electric actuator) to open louvers blocking the heated air exit, rather than a gravity-operated actuator.
- Control of jacket water temperature by radiator louvers in lieu of a bypass for freeze protection.
- Thermostatically controlled shutters that regulate airflow to maintain the desired temperature range. In cold climates, louvers should be closed when the engine is shut down to help maintain engine ambient temperature at a safe level. A crankcase heater can be installed on back-up systems located in unheated spaces.
- Positioning the engine so that the radiator face is in a direct line with an air exit leeward of the prevailing wind.
- An easily removable shroud so that exhaust air cannot reenter the radiator.
- Separation of units in a multiple-unit installation to avoid air short-circuiting among them.
- Low-temperature protection against snow and ice formation.
- Propeller fans cannot be attached to long ducts because they can only achieve low static pressure.
- Radiator cooling air directed over the engine promotes good circulation around the engine; thus, the engine runs cooler than for airflow in the opposite direction.
- Adequate sizing to dissipate the other areas of heat emissions to the engine room.

Sufficient ventilation must also be provided to protect against minor fuel supply leaks (not rupture of the supply line). Minimum ventilation air requirements are provided in Table 10. Ventilation may be provided by a fan that induces the draft through a sleeve surrounding the exhaust pipe. Slightly positive pressure should be maintained in the engine room.

Ventilation efficiency for operator comfort and equipment reliability is improved by (1) taking advantage of a full wiping effect across sensitive components (e.g., electrical controls and switchgear) with the coolest air; (2) taking cool air in as low as possible and forcing it to travel at occupancy level; (3) letting cooling air pass subsequently over the hottest components; (4) exhausting from the upper, hotter strata; (5) avoiding short-circuiting of cool air directly to the exhaust while bypassing equipment; and (6) arranging equipment locations, when possible, to allow the desired an airflow path.

Larger engines with off-engine filters should accomplish the following:

- Temper cold outdoor combustion air when its temperature is low enough to delay ignition timing and inhibit good combustion, which leads to a smoky exhaust.
- Allow the silencer and/or recovery device's hot surfaces to warm cold air to an automatically controlled temperature. As this air enters the machine room, it also provides some cooling to a hot machine room or heating to a cold room.
- Manipulate dampers with a thermostat, which is reset by room temperature, at the inlet to the machine room.
- Cool hot combustion air with a cooling device downstream of the air filter to increase engine performance. This is particularly helpful with large, slow-speed, naturally aspirated engines. The Diesel Engine Manufacturers Association (DEMA 1972) recommended that engines rated at 32°C and 450 m above sea level be derated in accordance with the particular manufacturer's ratings. In a naturally aspirated engine, a rating of 100 kW at 450 m drops to 50 kW at 4900 m. Also, a rating can drop from 100 kW at 32°C to 88 kW at 59°C.

Operation and Maintenance

Preventive Maintenance. One of the most important provisions for healthy and continuous plant operation is implementing a comprehensive preventive maintenance program. This should include written schedules of daily wipedown and observation of equipment, weekly and periodic inspection for replacement of degradable components, engine oil analysis, and maintenance of proper water treatment. Immediate access to repair services may be furnished by subcontract or by in-house plant personnel. Keep an inventory of critical parts on site. (See Chapters 38 to 45 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for further information on building operation and maintenance.)

Predictive Maintenance. Given the tremendous advancement and availability of both fixed and portable instrumentation for monitoring sound, vibration, temperatures, pressures, flow, and other online characteristics, many key aspects of equipment and system performance can be logged manually or by computer to observe trends. Factors such as fuel rate, heat exchanger approach, and cylinder operating condition can be compared against new and/or opti-

mized baseline conditions to indicate when maintenance may be required. This monitoring allow periods between procedures to be longer, catches incipient problems before they create outages or major repairs, and avoids unnecessary maintenance.

Equipment Rotation. When more than one engine, pump, or other component is serving a given distribution system, it is undesirable to operate the units with the equal life approach mode, which puts each unit in the same state of wear and component deterioration. If only one standby unit (or none) is available to a given battery of equipment, and one unit suffers a major failure or shutdown, all units now needed to carry the full load would be prone to additional failure while the first failed unit undergoes repair.

The preferred operating procedure is to keep one unit in continuous reserve, with the shortest possible running hours between overhauls or major repair, and to schedule operation of all others for unequal running hours. Thus any two units would have a minimum statistical chance of a simultaneous failure. All units, however, should be used for several hours in any week.

Engines require periodic servicing and replacement of parts, depending on usage and the type of engine. Transmission drives require periodic gearbox oil changes and the operation and care of external lubricating pumps. Log records should be kept of all servicing; checklists should be used for this purpose.

Table 12 shows ranges of typical maintenance routines for both diesel and gas-fired engines, based on the number of hours run. The actual intervals vary according to the cleanliness of the combustion air, cleanliness of the engine room, engine manufacturer's recommendations, number of engine starts and stops, and lubricating conditions indicated by oil analysis. With some engines and some operating conditions, the intervals between procedures listed in Table 12 may be extended.

A preventive maintenance program should include inspections for

Table 12 Recommended Engine Maintenance

Procedure	Hours Between Procedures: Diesel Fueled Engine	Hours Between Procedures: Gaseous Fueled Engine
1. Take lubricating oil sample	Once per month plus once at each oil change	Once per month plus once at each oil change
2. Change lubricating oil filters	350 to 750	500 to 1000
3. Clean air cleaners, fuel	350 to 750	350 to 750
4. Clean fuel filters	500 to 750	n.a.
5. Change lubricating oil	500 to 1000	1000 to 2000
6. Clean crankcase breather	350 to 700	350 to 750
7. Adjust valves	1000 to 2000	1000 to 2000
8. Lubricate tachometer, fuel priming pump, and auxiliary drive bearings	1000 to 2000	1000 to 2000 (fuel pump n.a.)
9. Service ignition system; adjust breaker gap, timing, spark plug gap, and magneto	n.a.	1000 to 2000
10. Check transistorized magneto	n.a.	6000 to 8000
11. Flush lubrication oil piping system	3000 to 5000	3000 to 5000
12. Change air cleaner	2000 to 3000	2000 to 3000
13. Replace turbocharger seals and bearings	4000 to 8000	4000 to 8000
14. Replace piston rings, cylinder liners (if applicable), connecting rod bearings, and cylinder heads; recondition or replace turbochargers; replace gaskets and seals	8000 to 12 000	8000 to 12 000
15. Same as item 14, plus recondition or replace crankshaft; replace all bearings	24 000 to 36 000	24 000 to 36 000

- Leaks (a visual inspection, which is facilitated by a clean engine)
- Abnormal sounds and odors
- Unaccountable speed changes
- Condition of fuel and lubricating oil filters

Daily logs should be kept on all pertinent operating parameters, such as

- Water and lubricating oil temperatures
- Individual cylinder compression pressures, which are useful in indicating blowby
- Changes in valve tappet clearance, which indicate the extent of wear in the valve system

Lubricating oil analysis is a low-cost method of determining the engine's physical condition and a guide to maintenance procedures. Commercial laboratories providing this service are widely available. The analysis should measure the concentration of various elements found in the lubricating oil, such as bearing metals, silicates, and calcium. It should also measure the dilution of the oil, suspended and nonsuspended solids, water, and oil viscosity. The laboratory can often help interpret readings and alert the user to impending problems.

Lubricating oil manufacturers' recommendations should be followed. Both the crankcase oil and oil filter elements should be changed at least once every six months.

4.2 COMBUSTION TURBINES

Types

Combustion gas turbines, although originally used for aircraft propulsion, have been developed for stationary use as prime movers. Turbines are available in sizes from 28 kW to 480 MW and can burn a wide range of liquid and gaseous fuels. Turbines, and some dual-fuel engines, can shift from one fuel to another without loss of service. **Microturbine** systems typically have capacities below 500 kW, although this is a subjective cutoff.

Combustion turbines consist of an air compressor section to boost combustion air pressure, a combination fuel/air mixing and combustion chamber (combustor), and an expansion power turbine section that extracts energy from the combustion gases. Simple-cycle combustion gas turbines have thermal efficiency levels of 25 to 32% HHV (28 to 36% LHV). Recuperative combustion gas turbines have thermal efficiency levels of 35% HHV (39% LHV).

In addition to these components, some turbines use regenerators and recuperators as heat exchangers to preheat combustion air with heat from the turbine discharge gas, thereby increasing machine efficiency. Most microturbine units are currently designed for continuous-duty operation and are recuperated to obtain higher electric efficiencies levels of 23 to 30% HHV (26 to 33% LHV) for sizes 250 kW and below. Unrecuperated engines or simple cycles have lower electric efficiencies but higher exhaust temperatures, which make them better suited for some CHP applications. Most turbines are the single-shaft type, (i.e., air compressor, turbine, and generator on a common shaft). However, dual-shaft machines that use one turbine stage on the same shaft as the compressor and a separate power turbine driving the output shaft are available.

Turbines rotate at speeds varying from 3600 to 100 000 rpm and often need speed-reduction gearboxes to obtain shaft speeds suitable for generators or other machinery. Many microturbine designs directly couple a high-speed turbine to a wide-frequency alternator whose high-frequency AC power is converted to DC by a rectifier and then to 60 Hz ac by an inverter to utility voltage and frequency specifications. Turbine motion is completely rotary and relatively vibration-free. This feature, coupled with low mass and high power output, provides an advantage over reciprocating engines in space, foundation requirements, and ease of start-up.

Combustion turbines have the following advantages and disadvantages compared to other internal combustion engine drivers:

Advantages

- Small size, high power-to-mass ratio
- Ability to burn a variety of fuels, though more limited than reciprocating engines
- Ability to meet stringent pollution standards
- High reliability
- Available in self-contained packages
- Little or no cooling water required
- Vibration-free operation
- Easy maintenance
- Low installation cost
- Clean, dry exhaust
- Lubricating oil not contaminated by combustion oil

Disadvantages

- Tend to be more complicated devices
- Lower electrical output efficiency compared to internal combustion engines
- Higher capital (first) costs
- More specialized maintenance requirements

Gas Turbine Cycle

The basic gas turbine cycle (Figure 21) is the **Brayton cycle (open cycle)**, which consists of adiabatic compression, constant-pressure heating, and adiabatic expansion. Figure 21 shows that the thermal efficiency of a gas turbine falls below the ideal value because of inefficiencies in the compressor and turbine and because of duct losses. Entropy increases during the compression and expansion processes, and the area enclosed by points 1, 2, 3, and 4 is reduced. This loss of area is a direct measure of the loss in efficiency of the cycle.

Nearly all turbine manufacturers present gas turbine engine performance in terms of power and specific fuel consumption. A comparison of fuel consumption in specific terms is the quickest way to compare overall thermal efficiencies of gas turbines (ASME *Standard* PTC 22).

Components

Figure 22 shows the major components of the gas turbine unit, which include the air compressor, combustor, and power turbine. Atmospheric air is compressed by the air compressor. Fuel is then injected into the airstream and ignited in the combustor, with leaving gases reaching temperatures between 870 and 1370°C. These high-pressure hot gases are then expanded through a turbine, which provides not only the power required by the air compressor, but also power to drive the load.

Gas turbines are available in two major classifications: single-shaft (Figure 22) and dual-shaft (Figure 23). The **single-shaft turbine** has the air compressor, gas-producer turbine, and power turbine on the same shaft. The **dual-shaft** or **split-shaft turbine** has the section required for air compression on one shaft and the section producing output power on a separate shaft. For a dual-shaft turbine, the portion that includes the compressor, combustion chamber, and first turbine section is the hot-gas generator or gas producer. The second turbine section is the power turbine.

The turbine used depends on job requirements. Single-shaft engines are usually selected when a constant-speed drive is required, as in generator drives, and when starting torque requirements are low. A single-shaft engine can be used to drive centrifugal compres-

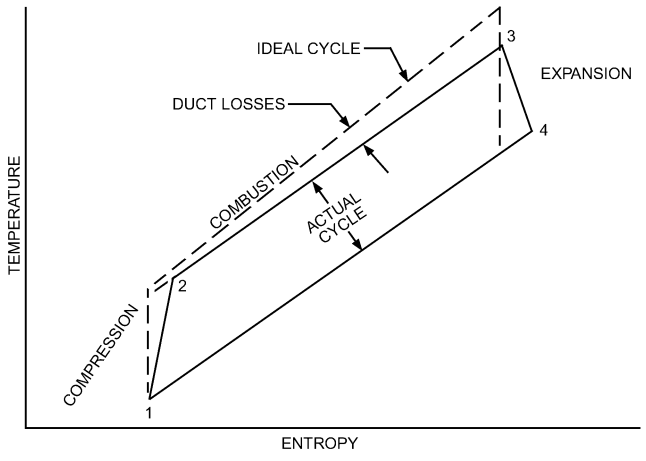


Fig. 21 Temperature-Entropy Diagram for Brayton Cycle

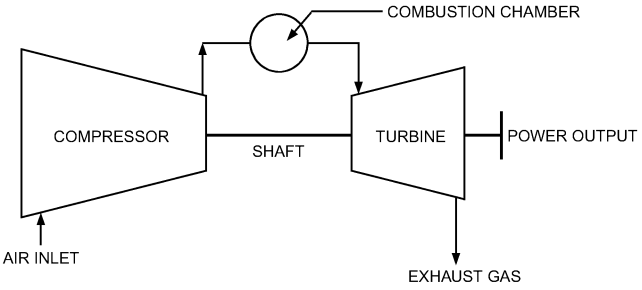
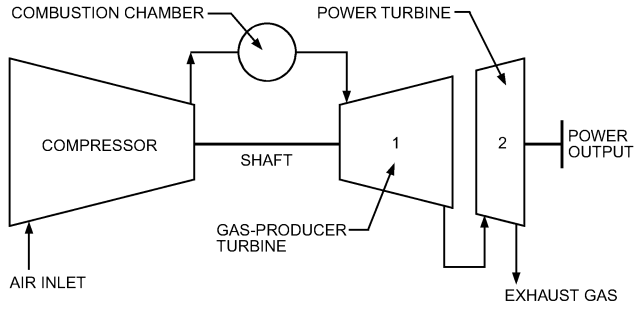


Fig. 22 Simple-Cycle Single-Shaft Turbine



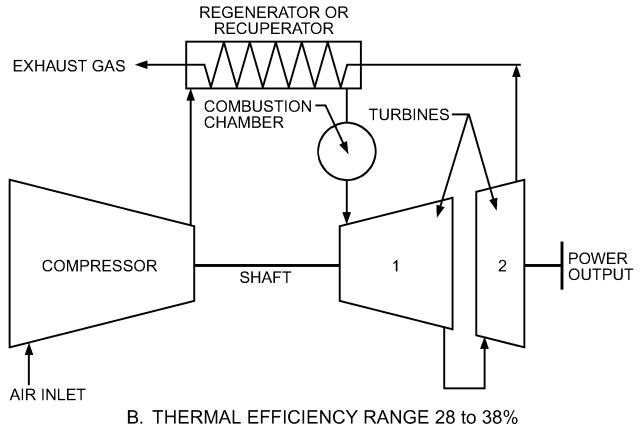


Fig. 23 Simple-Cycle Dual-Shaft Turbines

sors, but the starting system and the compressor match point must be considered. Dual-shaft engines allow for variable speed at full load and can easily be started with a high torque load connected to the power output shaft, and the power turbine can be more optimally configured to match load requirements.

4.3 PERFORMANCE CHARACTERISTICS

A gas turbine's rating is greatly affected by altitude, ambient temperature, inlet pressure to the air compressor, and exhaust pressure from the turbine. In most applications, filters and silencers must be installed in the air inlet. Silencers, waste heat recovery units, or both are used on the exhaust. The pressure drop of these accessories and piping losses must be considered when determining the power output of the unit.

Gas turbine ratings are usually given at standard conditions defined by the International Organization for Standardization (ISO): 15°C, 60% rh, and sea-level pressure at the air compressor's inlet flange and turbine's exhaust flange. Corrections for other conditions must be obtained from the manufacturer, because they vary with each model, depending primarily on gas turbine efficiency. Inlet air cooling has been used to increase capacity. The following approximations may be used for design considerations:

- Each 10 K rise in inlet temperature typically decreases power output by 9%.
- An increase of 300 m in altitude decreases power output by approximately 3.5%.
- Inlet pressure loss in filter, silencer, and ducting decreases power output by approximately 2% per kPa pressure loss.
- Discharge pressure loss in waste heat recovery units, silencer, and ducting decreases power output by approximately 1.2% per kPa pressure loss.

Gas turbines operate with a wide range of fuels.

Figure 24 shows a typical performance curve for a 7.5 MW turbine engine. For example, at an air inlet temperature of 30°C, the engine develops its maximum power at about 82% of maximum speed. The shaft thermal efficiency of the prime mover is 18 to 36% with exhaust gases from the turbine ranging from 430 to 530°C. If the exhaust heat can be used, overall thermal utilization efficiency can increase.

Figure 23B shows a regenerator that uses exhaust gas heat to heat air from the compressor before combustion. Overall shaft efficiency can be increased from 25 to 36% HHV (28 to 39% LHV) by using a regenerator or recuperator.

If process heat is required, turbine exhaust can satisfy some of that heat, and the combined system is a CHP system. The exhaust can be used (1) directly as a source of hot air, to drive an exhaust-fired absorption chiller, regenerate desiccant materials in a direct-fired dehumidifier, activate a thermal enthalpy wheel, or operate a bottoming cycle (e.g., Rankine) to generate electric or shaft power; (2) in a large boiler or furnace as a source of preheated combustion air or cofiring an absorption chiller (exhaust typically contains 16% or higher oxygen levels); or (3) to heat a process or working fluid such as the steam system shown in Figure 25. Overall thermal efficiency around the CHP system boundary (Figure 26) is [(net electrical energy output + useful thermal energy output) × 100]/(energy input from fuel). Thermal efficiencies of these systems vary from 50% to greater than 70%. The exhaust of a gas turbine has about 1.5 to 3 kW of available heat energy per kilowatt output.

Additionally, because of the high oxygen content, the exhaust stream can typically support the combustion of an additional 12 kW of fuel per watt output. This additional heat can then be used for processes in general manufacturing operations.

Fuels and Fuel Systems

The ability to burn almost any combustible fluid is a key advantage of the gas turbine. However, natural gas is preferred over other gaseous fuels because it is readily available, has good combustion characteristics, and is relatively easy to handle. A typical fuel gas control system is a two-stage system that uses pressure control in combination with flow control to achieve a turndown ratio of about 100:1. Other fuel gases include liquefied petroleum gases, which are considered "wet" gases because they can form condensables at normal gas turbine operating conditions, and a wide range of refinery waste and coal-derived gases, which have a rela-

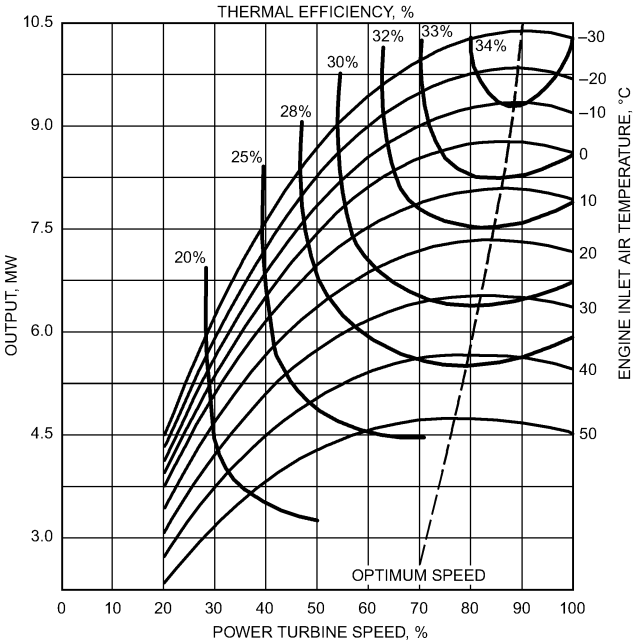


Fig. 24 Turbine Engine Performance Characteristics

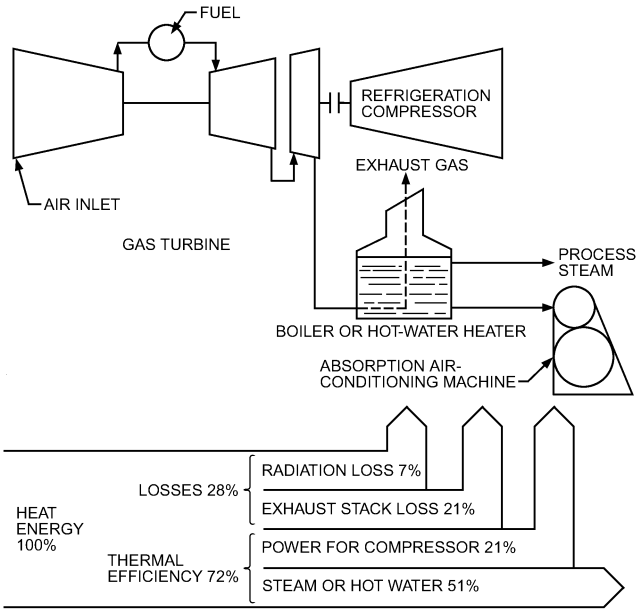


Fig. 25 Gas Turbine Refrigeration System Using Exhaust Heat

tively high fraction of hydrogen. Both of these features lead to problems in fuel handling and preparation, as well as in gas turbine operation. Heat tracing to heat the piping and jacketing of valves is required to prevent condensation at start-up. Piping runs should be designed to eliminate pockets where condensate might drop out and collect. Low-heat-value fuels from waste gas sites such as landfills or wastewater treatment plants may be used by gas turbines, although significant fuel conditioning is often needed to remove moisture and contaminants such as siloxane.

Distillate oil is the most common liquid fuel and, except for a few installations where natural gas is not available, is primarily used as a back-up and alternative start-up fuel. Crude oils are common primary fuels in many oil-producing countries because of their abundance. Both crude and residual oils require treatment for sodium salts and vanadium contamination. The most common multiple-fuel combination is natural gas and distillate. The combustion turbine may be started on either fuel, and can transfer from one fuel to the other any time after completing the starting sequence without interrupting operation.

Steam and demineralized water injection are sometimes used in gas turbines for NO_x abatement in quantities up to 2% of compressor inlet airflow. Additional steam may be injected independently at the compressor discharge for power augmentation. The required steam conditions are 2.1 to 2.4 MPa and a temperature no more than 80 K above compressor discharge temperature, but not less than 28 K of superheat. Guard against steam contaminants, and design the steam supply system to supply dry steam under all operating conditions.

Combustion Air

Combustion turbine inlet cooling (CTIC) systems increase the capacity of turbine-generators by increasing combustion air density. Because volumetric flow to most turbines is constant, increasing air density increases mass flow rate. As inlet air temperature increases, (e.g., on hot summer days), capacity decreases (MacCracken 1994). Cooling inlet air increases the power and typically decreases the heat rate, after all parasitic cooling power usage is considered (Punwani 2003; Punwani and Hurlbert 2005). Factors that affect CTIC installation and operation include turbine type, climate, hours of operation, ratio of airflow rate to power generated, ratio of generation increase with increased airflow, and monetary value of power generated. Detailed information is available in Chapter 8 and from sources such as the Turbine Inlet Cooling Association (www.turbineinletcooling.org).

Lubricating Systems

Lubricating systems provide filtered and cooled oil to the gas turbine, driven equipment, and gear reducer, and typically include a motor-driven, start-up/coast-down oil pump; a primary oil pump mounted on and driven by the gear reducer; filters; oil reservoir; oil cooler; and automatic controls. Along with lubricating the gas turbine bearings, gear reducer, and driven equipment bearings, the lubrication system sometimes provides hydraulic oil to the gas turbine control system and can be used to drive a hydraulic starter.

The start-up/coast-down oil pump circulates oil until the gas turbine reaches a speed at which the primary pump can take over. If emergency alternating current (AC) power is not available in case of lost external power, an emergency direct current (DC) motor-driven pump may be required to provide lubricant during start-up and coast-down.

Oil filters serve the pumps' full flow. Two filters are sometimes provided so that one can be changed while the other remains in operation.

The oil reservoir is mounted in the base of the gas turbine's supporting structure. Heater systems in the reservoir maintain oil temperature above a minimum level. A combination mechanical/coalescer filter in the reservoir's vent removes oil from the vent. The oil cooler can be either water or air cooled, depending on cooling water availability.

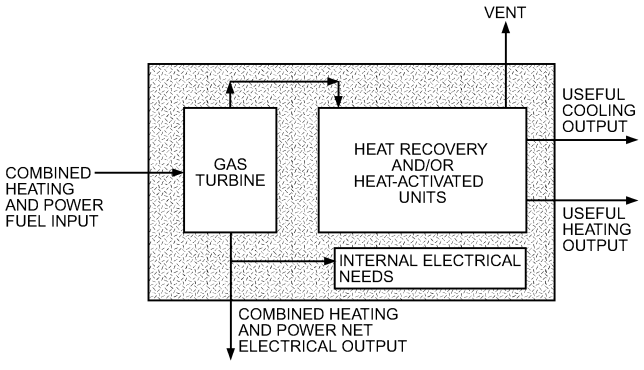


Fig. 26 CHP System Boundary

Starting Systems

Starting systems can use pneumatic, hydraulic, or electric motor starters. A pneumatic starting system uses either compressed air or fuel gas to power a pneumatic starter motor or a starting subsystem integrated directly with the rotating components. A hydraulic system uses a hydraulic motor for starting. Hydraulic fluid is provided to the hydraulic motor by either an AC-motor-driven pump or a diesel-engine-driven pump. An electric motor system couples an electric motor directly to the gas engine for starting. All direct-coupled systems use a one-way clutch to couple the starter motor to the gas engine so that, as the engine accelerates above the start speed, the starter can shut down. To perform black starts, include some form of external energy storage or drive system in the starting system.

Exhaust Systems

Exhaust systems of gas turbines used in CHP systems consist of gas ducts, expansion joints, an exhaust silencer, a dump (or bypass) stack, and a diverter valve (or damper). The exhaust silencer, if needed, is installed in a dump stack. The diverter valve modulates the flow of exhaust gas into the heat recovery equipment or diverts 100% of the exhaust gas to the dump stack when heat recovery is not required.

Emissions

Gas turbine power plants emit relatively low levels of CO_x and NO_x compared to other internal combustion engines; however, for each application, the gas turbine manufacturer should be consulted to ensure that applicable codes are met. Take special care if high-sulfur fuel is being used, because gas turbine exhaust stacks are typically not high, and dilution is not possible.

Instruments and Controls

Control systems are typically microprocessor-based. The control system sequences all systems during starting and normal operation, monitors performance, and protects the equipment. The operator interface is a monitor and keyboard, with analog gages for redundancy.

When operating the gas turbine engine at its maximum rating is desirable, the load is controlled based on the temperature of combustion gases in the turbine section and on the ambient air temperature. When the engine combustion gas temperature reaches a set value, the control system begins to control the engine so that the load (and therefore the temperature) does not increase further. With changes in ambient air temperature, the control system adjusts the load to maintain the set temperature value in the gas engine's turbine section. When maintaining a constant load level is desirable, the

Table 13 Overview of Fuel Cell Characteristics

	Phosphoric Acid (PAFC)	Solid Oxide (SOFC)	Molten Carbonate (MCFC)	Proton Exchange Membrane (PEMFC)
Commercially available	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Size range	100 to 200 kW	1 kW to 10 MW	250 kW to 10 MW	500 W to 250 kW
Efficiency (LHV)	40%	45 to 60%	45 to 55%	30 to 40%
Efficiency (HHV)	36%	40 to 54%	40 to 50%	27 to 36%
Average operating temperature	200°C	980°C	650°C	90°C
Heat recovery characteristics	Hot water	Hot water/steam	Hot water, steam	60°C water

Source: Adapted from Foley and Sweetser (2002).

control system allows the operator to dial in any load, and the system controls the engine accordingly.

Noise and Vibration

Gas turbine manufacturers have developed sound-attenuated enclosures that cover the turbine and gear package. Turbine drivers, when properly installed with a sound-attenuated enclosure, inlet silencer, and exhaust silencer, meet the strictest noise standards. The turbine manufacturer should be consulted for detailed noise level data and recommendations on the least expensive method of attenuation for a particular installation.

Operation and Maintenance

Industrial gas turbines are designed to operate for 12 000 to 30 000 h between overhauls, with normal maintenance, which includes checking filters and oil level, inspecting for leaks, etc., all of which can be done by the operator with ordinary mechanics' tools. However, factory-trained service personnel are required to inspect engine components such as combustors and nozzles. These inspections, depending on the manufacturer's recommendations, are required as frequently as every 4000 h of operation.

Most gas turbines are maintained by condition monitoring and inspection (predictive maintenance) rather than by specific overhaul intervals. Gas turbines specifically designed for industrial applications may have an indefinite life for the major housings, shafts, and low-temperature components. Hot-section repair intervals for combustor and turbine components can vary from 10 000 to 100 000 h. The total cost of maintaining a gas turbine includes (1) cost of operator time, (2) normal parts replacement, (3) lubricating oil, (4) filter changes (combustion inlet air, fuel, and lubricating oil), (5) overhauls, and (6) factory service time (to conduct engine inspections). The cost of all these items can be estimated by the manufacturer and must be taken into account to determine the total operating cost.

Chapter 40 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* has more information on operation and maintenance management.

4.4 FUEL CELLS

Types

Fuel cells convert chemical energy of a hydrogen-based fuel directly into electricity without combustion. In the cell, a hydrogen-rich fuel passes over the anode, while an oxygen-rich gas (air) passes over the cathode. Catalysts help split the hydrogen into hydrogen ions and electrons. The hydrogen ions move through an external circuit, thus providing a direct current at a fixed voltage potential. A typical packaged fuel cell power plant consists of a fuel reformer (processor), which generates hydrogen-rich gas from fuel; a power section (stack) where the electrochemical process occurs; and a power conditioner (inverter), which converts the DC power generated in the fuel cell into AC power. Most fuel cell applications involve interconnectivity with the electric grid; thus, the power conditioner must synchronize the fuel cell's electrical output with the grid (ASHRAE 2001; ASME *Standard* PTC 50). A growing number of fuel cell applications are grid independent to reliably power remote or critical systems.

Most fuel cells have similar designs, but differ in the type of electrolyte used. The main types of fuel cells, classified by their electrodes, are (1) phosphoric acid (PAFC), (2) molten carbonate (MCFC), (3) solid oxide (SOFC), (4) proton exchange membrane (PEMFC), and (5) alkaline (AFC). PAFCs, MCFCs, and PEMFCs are commercially available, AFCs are used for space power, and SOFCs are in development and testing. The most significant research and development activities focus on PEMFC for automotive and home use and SOFC for stationary applications. Efficiencies of several types of fuel cells are shown in Table 13 (Foley and Sweetser 2002). Emissions from fuel cells are very low; NO_x emissions are less than 20 ppm. Large phosphoric acid fuel cells are commercially available.

Phosphoric Acid Fuel Cells (PAFCs). PAFCs are generally considered first-generation technology (Figure 27). They operate at about 200°C and achieve 40% LHV efficiencies. PAFCs use liquid phosphoric acid as an electrolyte. Platinum-catalyzed, porous-carbon electrodes are used for both the cathode and anode. For each type of fuel cell, the reformer supplies hydrogen gas to the anode through a process in which hydrocarbons, water, and oxygen react to produce hydrogen, carbon dioxide, and carbon monoxide. At the anode, hydrogen is split into two hydrogen ions (H^+) and two electrons. The ions pass through the electrolyte to the cathode, and the electrons pass through the external circuit to the cathode. At the cathode, the hydrogen, electrons, and oxygen combine to form water.

Solid-Oxide Fuel Cells (SOFCs). SOFCs operate at temperatures up to 980°C, offering enhanced heat recovery performance (Figure 28). A solid-oxide system typically uses a hard ceramic material instead of a liquid electrolyte. The solid-state ceramic construction is a more stable and reliable design, enabling high temperatures and more flexibility in fuel choice. SOFCs can reach 54% HHV (60% LHV) efficiencies. Combined-cycle applications could reach system efficiencies up to 77% HHV (85% LHV).

SOFCs can use carbon monoxide as well as hydrogen as direct fuel. Hydrogen and carbon monoxide in the fuel stream react with oxide ions from the electrolyte, producing water and carbon dioxide, and releasing electrons into the anode. The electrons pass outside the fuel cell, through the load, and back to the cathode. At the cathode, oxygen molecules from the air receive the electrons and the molecules are converted into oxide ions. These ions are injected back into the electrolyte.

Molten-Carbonate Fuel Cells (MCFCs). MCFCs can reach 50% HHV (55% LHV) efficiencies (Figure 29). Combined-cycle applications could reach system thermal efficiencies of 77% HHV (85% LHV). MCFCs operate on hydrogen, carbon monoxide, natural gas, propane, landfill gas, marine diesel, and simulated coal gasification products. Operating temperatures are around 650°C. This high operating temperature makes direct operation on gaseous hydrocarbon fuels (e.g., natural gas) possible. Natural gas can be reformed internally in MCFCs to produce hydrogen.

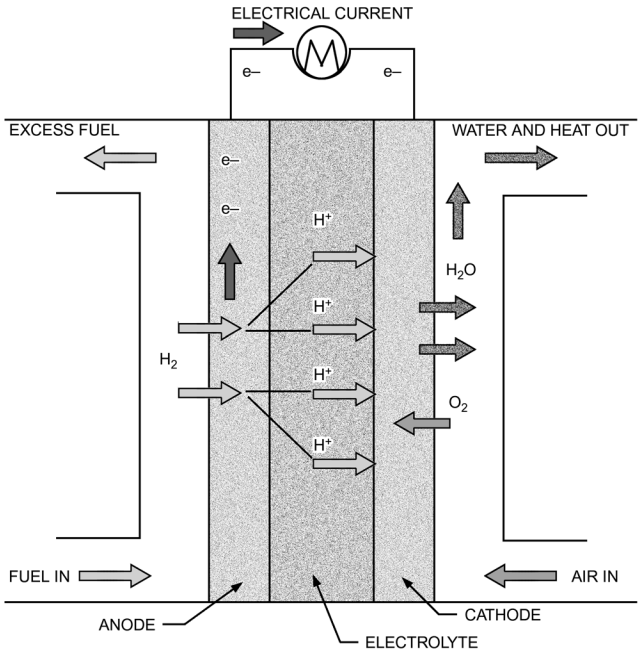


Fig. 27 PAFC

(DOE 2007a)

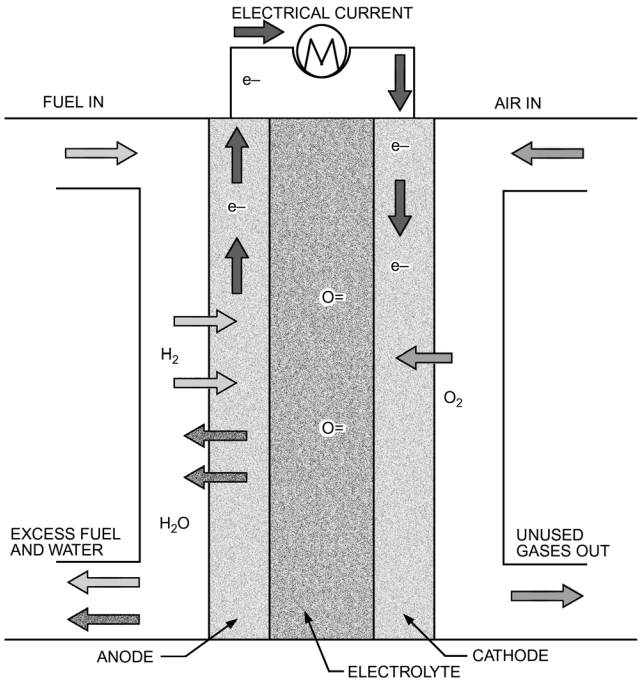


Fig. 28 SOFC

(DOE 2007a)

MCFCs use a molten carbonate salt mixture as an electrolyte; the electrolyte composition varies, but usually consists of lithium carbonate and potassium carbonate. The salt mixture is liquid and a good ionic conductor at the MCFC's high operating temperature. An electrochemical reaction occurs at the anode between the hydrogen fuel and carbonate ions from the electrolyte. This reaction produces water and carbon dioxide, and releases electrons to the anode. At the cathode, oxygen and carbon dioxide from the oxidant stream combine with electrons from the anode to produce carbonate ions, which enter the electrolyte.

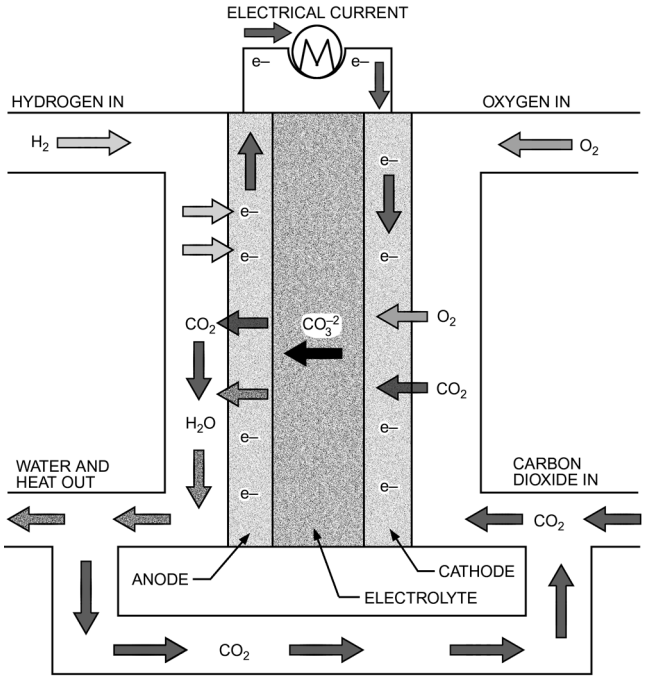


Fig. 29 MCFC

(DOE 2007a)

Proton Exchange Membrane Fuel Cells (PEMFCs). PEMFCs can reach 36% HHV (40% LHV) efficiencies. PEMFCs contain a thin plastic polymer membrane through which hydrogen ions can pass. The membrane is coated on both sides with highly dispersed metal alloy particles (mostly platinum) that are active catalysts (Figure 30). Because the electrolyte is a solid polymer, electrolyte loss does not affect stack life. Using a solid electrolyte eliminates the safety concerns and corrosive effects associated with liquid electrolytes. PEMFCs operate at relatively low temperatures (approximately 90°C).

Electrode reactions in the PEMFC are analogous to those in the PAFC. Hydrogen ions and electrons are produced from the fuel gas at the anode. At the cathode, oxygen combines with electrons from the anode and hydrogen ions from the electrolyte to produce water. The solid electrolyte does not absorb the water, which is rejected from the back of the cathode into the oxidant gas stream (Hodge and Hardy 2002).

Hydrogen is delivered to the anode side of the membrane-electrode assembly (MEA), where it is catalytically split into protons and electrons. The protons move through the polymer electrolyte membrane to the cathode side, and the electrons travel to the cathode side along an external load circuit, creating the fuel cell's current output.

Meanwhile, oxygen is delivered to the cathode side of the MEA. The oxygen molecules react with protons and electrons coming from the anode side to form water molecules.

Alkaline Fuel Cells (AFCs). Alkaline fuel cells (AFCs) use a solution of potassium hydroxide in water as the electrolyte and various nonprecious metals as a catalyst at the anode and cathode (Figure 31). High-temperature AFCs operate between 100 and 250°C, although, newer designs operate at roughly 23 to 70°C.

AFCs' high performance derives from the rate at which chemical reactions take place in the cell. They have demonstrated efficiencies near 60% in space applications. AFC stacks maintain stable oper-

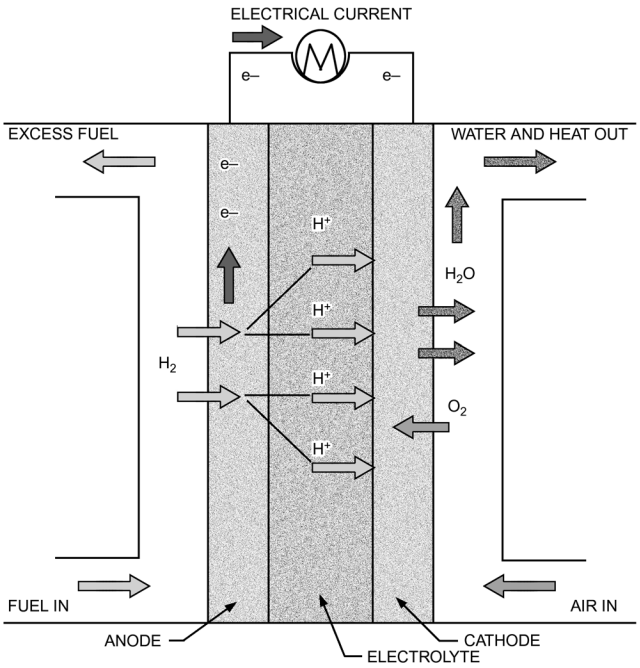


Fig. 30 PEMFC

(DOE 2007a)

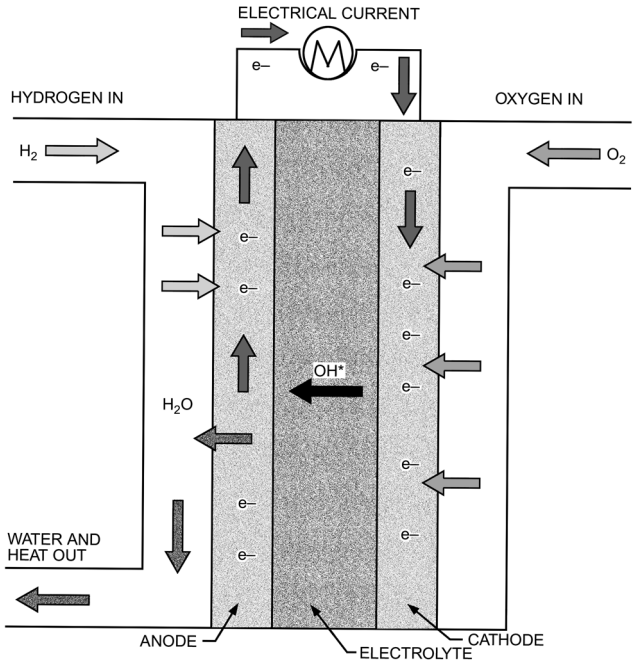


Fig. 31 AFC

(DOE 2007a)

ation for 8000 operating hours, which limits their commercial viability.

5. THERMAL-TO-POWER COMPONENTS

These devices convert thermal energy to useful power. They do not convert the fuel source directly to power; this separation of energy conversion enables these devices to operate with an enormous variety of fuels and waste heat.

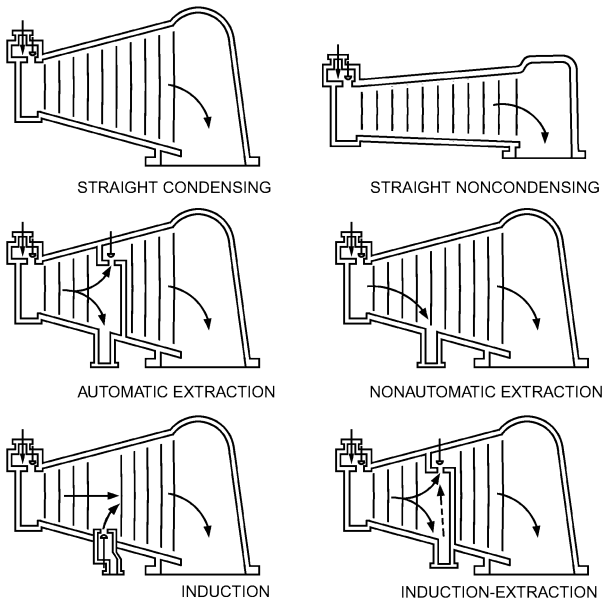


Fig. 32 Basic Types of Axial Flow Turbines

5.1 STEAM TURBINES

Steam turbines, which are among the oldest prime mover technologies, convert thermal energy from pressurized steam into useful power. They require a source of high-pressure steam produced in a boiler or HRSG. Most electricity in the United States is generated by conventional steam turbine power plants. Steam turbines are made in a variety of sizes, ranging from small 0.75 kW units to several hundred megawatts. In CHP applications, low-pressure steam from the turbine can be used directly in a process, or for district heating, or can be converted to other forms of useful thermal energy.

Types

Axial Flow Turbines. Conventional axial flow steam turbines direct steam axially through the peripheral blades of one or more staged turbine wheels (much like a pinwheel) one after another on the same shaft. Figure 32 shows basic types of axial turbines. NEMA *Standard* SM 24 defines these and further subdivisions of their basic families as follows:

Noncondensing (Back-Pressure) Turbine. A steam turbine designed to operate with an exhaust steam pressure at any level that may be required by a downstream process, where all condensing takes place.

Condensing Turbine. A steam turbine with an exhaust steam pressure below atmospheric pressure, such that steam is directly and completely condensed.

Automatic Extraction Turbine. A steam turbine that has opening(s) in the turbine casing for extracting steam and means for directly regulating the extraction steam pressure.

Nonautomatic Extraction Turbine. A steam turbine that has opening(s) in the turbine casing for extracting steam without a means for controlling its pressure.

Induction (Mixed-Pressure) Turbine. A steam turbine with separate inlets for steam at two pressures, with an automatic device for controlling the pressure of the secondary steam induced into the turbine and means for directly regulating the flow of steam to the turbine stages below the induction opening.

Induction-Extraction Turbine. A steam turbine that can either exhaust or admit a supplemental flow of steam through an intermediate port in the casing, thereby maintaining a process heat balance. Extraction and induction-extraction turbines may have several casing openings, each passing steam at a different pressure.

The necessary rotative force for shaft power in a turbine may be imposed through the steam's velocity, pressure energy, or both. If velocity energy is used, the movable wheels are usually fitted with crescent-shaped blades. A row of fixed nozzles in the steam chest increases steam velocity into the blades with little or no steam pressure drop across them, and causes wheel rotation. These combinations of nozzles and velocity-powered wheels are characteristic of an **impulse turbine**.

Reaction Turbine. A **reaction turbine** uses alternate rows of fixed and moving blades, generally of an airfoil shape. Steam velocity increases in the fixed nozzles and drops in the movable ones, and steam pressure drops through both.

The power capability of a reaction turbine is maximum when the moving blades travel at about the velocity of the steam passing through them; in the impulse turbine, maximum power is produced with a blade velocity of about 50% of steam velocity. Steam velocity is related directly to pressure drop. To achieve the desired relationship between steam velocity and blade velocity without resorting to large wheel diameters or high rotative speeds, most turbines include a series of impulse or reaction stages or both, thus dividing the total steam pressure drop into manageable increments. A typical commercial turbine may have two initial rows of rotating impulse blading with an intervening stationary row (called a **Curtis stage**), followed by several alternating rows of fixed and movable impulse- or reaction-type blading. Most multistage turbines use some degree of reaction.

Construction. Turbine manufacturers' standards prescribe casing materials for various limits of steam pressure and temperature. The choice between built-up or solid rotors depends on turbine speed or inlet steam temperature. Water must drain from pockets in the turbine casing to prevent damage from condensate accumulation. Carbon rings or closely fitted labyrinths prevent steam leakage between pressure stages of the turbine, outward steam leakage, and inward air leakage at the turbine glands. The erosive and corrosive effect of moisture entering with the supply steam must be considered. Heat loss is controlled by installation (often at the manufacturer's plant) of thermal insulation and protective metal jacketing on hotter portions of the turbine casing.

Radial Inflow Turbines. Radial inflow turbines have a radically different configuration from axial flow machines. Steam enters through the center or eye of the impeller and exits from the periphery, much like the path of fluid through a compressor or pump, but in this case the steam actuates the wheel, instead of the wheel actuating the air or water.

Radial, multistage arrangements comprise separate, single-stage wheels connected with integral reduction gearing in a factory-assembled package. Induction, extraction, and moisture elimination are accomplished in the piping between stages, giving the radial turbine a greater tolerance of condensate.

Performance Characteristics

The topping CHP-cycle steam turbine is typically either a back-pressure or extraction condensing type that makes downstream, low-pressure thermal energy available for process use. Bottoming cycles commonly use condensing turbines because these yield more power, having lower-grade entering turbine energy to begin with.

The highest steam plant efficiency is obtainable with a back-pressure turbine when 100% of its exhaust steam is used for thermal processes. The only inefficiencies are the gear drive, alternator, and inherent steam-generating losses. A large steam-system topping cycle using an efficient water-tube boiler, economizer, and preheater can easily achieve an overall efficiency (fuel to end use) of more than 90%.

Full condensing turbine heat rates (J/J or kJ/kWh) are the highest in the various steam cycles because the turbine's exhaust condenses, rejecting the latent heat of condensation (2410 kJ/kg at a condensing pressure of 7 kPa and 39°C) to a waste heat sink (e.g., a cooling tower or river).

Conversely, the incremental heat that must be added to a low-pressure (e.g., 200 kPa) steam flow to produce high-pressure, superheated steam for a topping cycle is only a small percentage of its latent heat of vaporization. For example, to produce 120°C, 200 kPa saturated steam for a single-stage absorption chiller in a low-pressure boiler requires 2706 kJ/kg, of which 2202 kJ/kg is the heat of vaporization. Boosting this to 315°C, 2200 kPa requires an additional 340 kJ/kg, which is only 15% of the latent heat at 200 kPa, for an enthalpy of 3046 kJ/kg.

A low-pressure boiler generating 200 kPa steam directly to the absorber has a 75% fuel-to-steam efficiency, which is 15% lower than the 90% efficiency of a high-pressure boiler used in the CHP cycle. Therefore, from the standpoint of fuel cost, the power generated by the back-pressure turbine is virtually free when its 200 kPa exhaust is discharged into the absorption chiller.

The potential power-generating capacity and size of the required turbine are determined by its efficiency and steam rate (or water rate). This capacity is, in turn, the system's maximum steam load, if the turbine is sized to satisfy this demand. Efficiencies range from 55 to 80% and are the ratio of actual to theoretical steam rate, or actual to theoretical enthalpy drop from throttle to exhaust conditions.

NEMA *Standard* SM 24 defines the theoretical steam rate as the quantity of steam per unit of power required by an ideal Rankine cycle, which is an isentropic or reversible adiabatic process of expansion. This can best be seen graphically on an enthalpy-entropy (Mollier) chart. Expressed algebraically, the steam rate is

$$w_t = \frac{3600}{h_i - h_e} \tag{1}$$

where

w_t = theoretical steam rate, kg/kWh
h_e = enthalpy of steam at exhaust pressure and inlet entropy, kJ/kg
h_i = enthalpy of steam at throttle inlet pressure and temperature, kJ/kg
3600 = kJ/kWh

This isentropic expansion through the turbine represents 100% conversion efficiency of heat energy to power. An example is shown on the Mollier chart in Figure 33 as the vertical line from 2200 kPa, 315°C, 3046 kJ/kg to 200 kPa, 120°C, 93% quality, 2560 kJ/kg.

On the other hand, zero efficiency is a throttling, adiabatic, non-reversible horizontal line terminating at 200 kPa, 289°C, 3046 kJ/kg. An actual turbine process would lie between 0 and 100% efficiency, such as the one shown at actual exhaust condition of saturated steam h_a at 200 kPa, 120°C, 2706 kJ/kg; the actual turbine efficiency is

$$E_a = \frac{h_i - h_a}{h_i - h_e} \tag{2}$$

and the actual steam rate is

$$w_a = \frac{3600}{h_i - h_a} \tag{3}$$

where

w_a = actual steam rate, kg/kWh
h_a = enthalpy of steam at actual exhaust conditions, kJ/kg
3600 = kJ/kWh

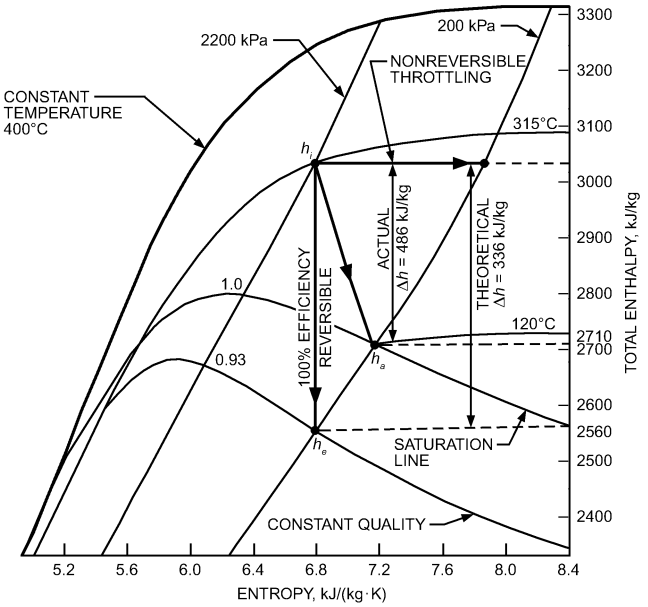


Fig. 33 Isentropic Versus Actual Turbine Process

For the case described,

$$E_a = \frac{3046 - 2706}{3046 - 2555} = 0.69 \text{ or } 69\%$$

As a CHP cycle, if the previously described absorption chiller has a capacity of 8800 kW, which requires 20.4 Mg/h of 200 kPa saturated steam, it can be provided by the 69% efficient turbine at an actual steam rate of 3600/340 = 10.6 kg/kWh; the potential power generation is

$$\frac{20.4 \times 1000}{10.6} = 1925 \text{ kWh}$$

The incremental turbine heat rate to generate this power is only

$$\frac{340 \times 20\,400}{1925} = 3600 \text{ kJ/kWh}$$

instead of a typical 9500 kJ/kWh (thermal efficiency of 38%) for an efficient steam power plant with full condensing turbines and cooling towers.

Turbine performance tests should be conducted in accordance with the appropriate American Society of Mechanical Engineers (ASME) *Performance Test Code:* PTC 6, PTC 6S Report, or PTC 6A. The steam rate of a turbine is reduced with higher turbine speeds, a greater number of stages, larger turbine size, and a higher difference in heat content between entering and leaving steam conditions. Often, one or more of these factors can be improved with only a nominal increase in initial capital cost. CHP applications range, with equal flow turbines, from approximately 75 to 7500 kW and from 3000 to 10 000 rpm, with high speeds generally associated with lower power outputs, and low speeds with higher power outputs. (Some typical characteristics of turbines driving centrifugal water chillers are shown in Figures 34 to 38.)

Initial steam pressures for small turbines commonly fall in the 700 to 1700 kPa (gage) range, but wide variations are possible. Turbines in the range of 1500 kW and above commonly have throttle pressures of 2800 kPa (gage) or greater.

Back pressure associated with noncondensing turbines generally ranges from 350 kPa (gage) to atmospheric, depending on the use for the exhaust steam. Raising the initial steam temperature by superheating improves steam rates.

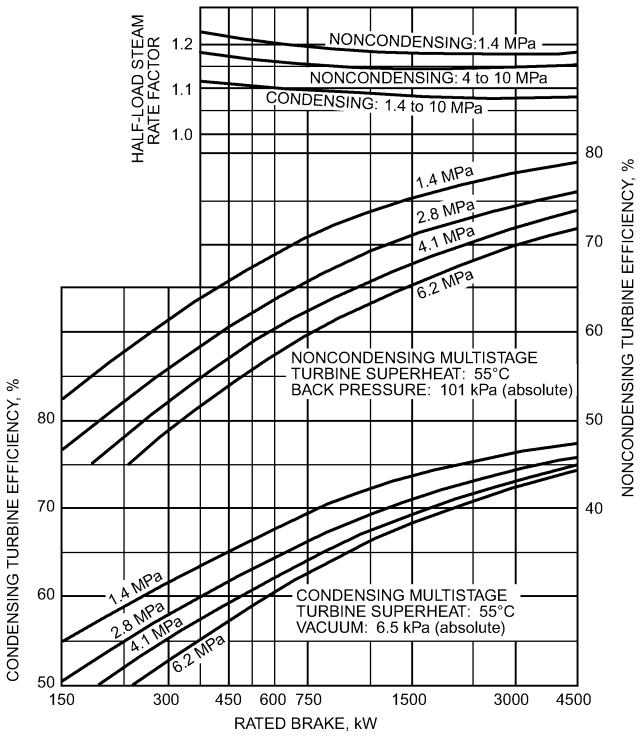


Fig. 34 Efficiency of Typical Multistage Turbines

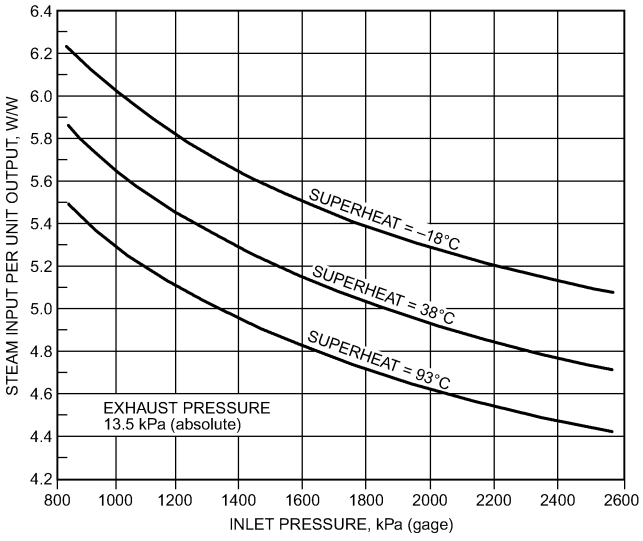


Fig. 35 Effect of Inlet Pressure and Superheat on Condensing Turbine

NEMA *Standards* SM 23 and SM 24 govern allowable deviations from design steam pressures and temperatures. Because of possible unpredictable variations in steam conditions and load requirements, turbines are selected for a power capability of 105 to 110% of design shaft output and speed capabilities of 105% of design rpm.

Because no rigid standards prevail for the turbine inlet steam pressure and temperature, fixed design conditions proposed by ASME/IEEE should be used to size the steam system initially. These values are 2800 kPa (gage) at 400°C, 4100 kPa (gage) at

Table 14 Theoretical Steam Rates For Turbines at Common Conditions, kg/kWh

Exhaust Pressure, kPa	Throttle Steam Conditions							
	1.03 MPa (gage), 186°C Saturated	1.38 MPa (gage), 198°C Saturated	1.72 MPa (gage), 260°C, 52°C Superheat	2.76 MPa (gage), 399°C, 168°C Superheat	4.14 MPa (gage), 399°C, 145°C Superheat	4.14 MPa (gage), 441°C, 187°C Superheat	5.86 MPa (gage), 441°C, 166°C Superheat	5.86 MPa (gage), 482°C, 207°C Superheat
7	4.77	4.54	4.11	3.34	3.22	3.07	2.98	2.85
14	5.33	5.04	4.54	3.62	3.47	3.30	3.20	3.05
0	8.79	7.94	6.88	5.08	4.72	4.45	4.22	4.00
69	10.87	9.57	8.12	5.77	5.28	4.97	4.67	4.40
207	15.24	12.72	10.41	6.91	6.18	5.78	5.35	5.02
345	20.87	16.33	12.79	7.97	6.97	6.49	5.93	5.54
414	24.45	18.33	14.11	8.50	7.34	6.83	6.20	5.78
483	28.80	20.68	15.47	9.05	7.71	7.16	6.45	6.01
517	31.43	22.00	16.24	9.34	7.89	7.33	6.58	6.13

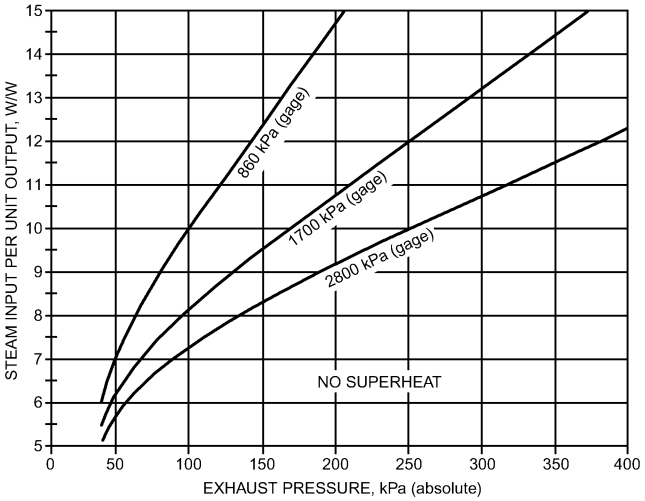


Fig. 36 Effect of Exhaust Pressure on Noncondensing Turbine

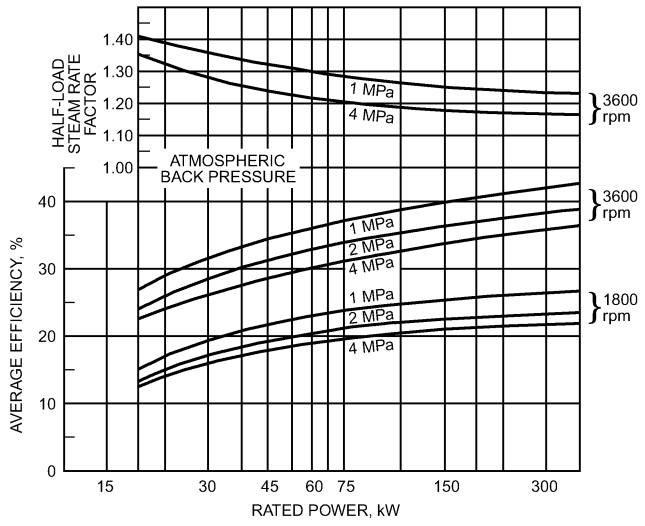


Fig. 37 Single-Stage Noncondensing Turbine Efficiency

440°C, 5900 kPa (gage) at 480°C, and 8600 kPa (gage) at 510 or 540°C.

Table 14 lists theoretical steam rates for steam turbines at common conditions. If project conditions dictate different throttle/exhaust conditions from the steam tables, theoretical steam rate tables or graphical Mollier chart analysis may be used.

Steam rates for multistage turbines depend on many variables and require extensive computation. Manufacturers provide simple tables and graphs to estimate performance, and these data are good guides for preliminary sizing of turbines and associated auxiliaries for the complete system.

Using the entire exhaust steam flow from a base-loaded back-pressure turbine achieves the maximum efficiency of a steam turbine CHP cycle. However, if the facility's thermal/electrical load cannot absorb the fully loaded output of the turbine, whichever profile is lower can be tracked, and the power output or steam flow is reduced unless the output remaining is exported. Annual efficiency can still be high if the machine operates at significant combined loads for substantial periods. Straight steam condensing turbines offer no opportunity for topping cycles but are not unusual in bottoming cycles because waste steam from the process can be most efficiently used by full-condensing turbines when there is no other use for low-pressure steam. Either back-pressure or extraction condensing turbines may be used as extraction turbines.

The steam in an extraction turbine expands part of the way through the turbine until the pressure and temperature required by the external thermal load are attained. The remaining steam continues through the low-pressure turbine stages; however, it is easier to adjust for noncoincident electrical and thermal loads.

Because steam cycles operate at pressures above those allowed by ASME and local codes for unattended operation, their use in CHP plants is limited to large systems where attendants are required for other reasons or the labor burden of operating personnel does not seriously affect overall project economics.

Figure 38 shows the performance of a 1500 kW extraction condensing turbine, indicating the effect of various extraction rates on total steam requirements as follows: at zero extraction and 1500 kW, 2.2 kg/s or a water rate of 5.29 kg/kWh is required. When 5.65 kg/s is extracted at 700 kPa (gage), only 0.5 kg/s more (6.15 – 5.65) is required at the throttle condition of 2800 kPa (gage) to develop the same 1500 kW, chargeable to the generation of electric power. The portion of input energy chargeable to the power is represented by the sum of the enthalpy of this 0.5 kg/s at throttle conditions and the difference in enthalpy between the throttle and extraction conditions of the extracted portion of steam.

In effect, as the extraction rate increases, overall efficiency increases. However at "full" extraction, a significant flow of "cooling" steam must still pass through the final turbine stages for condensing. At this condition, a simple back-pressure turbine would be more efficient, if all the exhaust steam could be used.

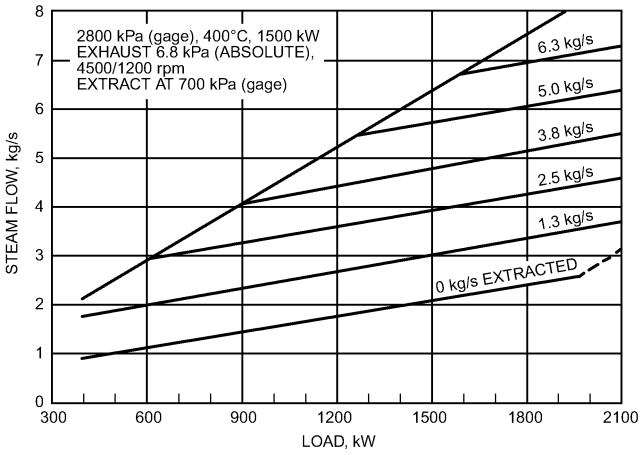


Fig. 38 Effect of Extraction Rate on Condensing Turbine

Full-condensing steam turbines have a maximum plant shaft efficiency (power output as a percentage of input fuel to the boiler) ranging from 20 to 36%, but have no useful thermal output. Therefore, with overall plant efficiencies no better than their shaft efficiencies, they are unsuitable for topping CHP cycles.

At maximum extraction, the heat/power ratio of extraction turbines is relatively high. This makes it difficult to match facility loads, except those with very high base thermal loads, if reasonable annual efficiencies are to be achieved. As extraction rates decrease, plant efficiency approaches that of a condensing turbine, but can never reach it. Thus, the 2.2 kg/s (5.29 kg/kWh) shown in Figure 38 at 1500 kW and zero extraction represents a steam-to-electric efficiency of 28.6%, but a fuel-to-electric efficiency of 25%, with a boiler plant efficiency of 85%, developed as follows:

Isentropic Δh from 2800 kPa (gage) steam to 6.8 kPa condensing pressure = 2380 kJ/kg output.

$$\text{Actual } \Delta h = \frac{3600 \text{ kJ/kWh}}{\text{Actual steam rate (kg/kWh)}}$$

Actual Δh = 3600/5.29 = 680 kJ/kg

Plant shaft efficiency = (100 × 0.85 × 680)/2380
= 24.3% (electric output to fuel energy input)

Radial inflow turbines are more efficient than single-stage axial flow turbines of the same output. They are available up to 11 MW from several manufacturers, with throttle steam up to 14.5 MPa, wheel speeds up to 60 000 rpm, and output shaft speeds as low as 3600 or 1800 rpm. It is these high wheel speeds that yield turbine efficiencies of 70 to 80%, compared with single-stage axial turbines spinning at only 10 000 rpm with efficiencies of up to 40%.

Fuel Systems

Unlike gas turbines and reciprocating engines, steam turbines normally generate electricity as a by-product of heat generation. These devices do not directly convert fuel to useful power; instead, thermal energy is transferred from the boiler or HRSG to these turbines. This separation of energy conversion enables steam turbines to operate with an enormous variety of fuels such as coal, oil, or natural gas or renewable fuels like wood or municipal waste.

Lubricating Oil Systems

Small turbines often have only simple oil rings to handle bearing lubrication, but most turbines for CHP service have a complete pressure lubrication system. Basic components include a shaft-driven oil pump, oil filter, oil cooler, means of regulating oil pressure, reservoir, and interconnecting piping. Turbines with a hydraulic governor may use oil from the lubrication circuit or, with some types of governors, use a self-contained governor oil system. To ensure an adequate supply of oil to bearings during acceleration and deceleration, many turbines include an auxiliary motor or turbine-driven oil pump. Oil pressure-sensing devices act in two ways: (1) to stop the auxiliary pump once the shaft-driven pump has attained proper flow and pressure or (2) to start the auxiliary pump if the shaft-driven pump fails or loses pressure when decelerating. In some industrial applications, the lubrication systems of the turbine and driven compressor are integrated. Proper oil pressure, temperature, and compatibility of lubricant qualities must be maintained.

Power Systems

Steam turbines are used for power only or in CHP applications. In CHP applications, low-pressure steam leaving the turbine is used directly in a process or for district heating, or converted to other forms of thermal energy. In power-only applications, condensing turbines are generally used to maximize electricity production by using fuels that otherwise would go to waste. Condensing turbines are also used in bottoming cycles for gas turbines to produce additional electricity in a combined cycle (gas turbine exhaust is used in a HRSG to generate high-pressure steam to drive the steam turbine) and improve the cycle's electric efficiency.

Exhaust Systems

Steam turbines can be driven with a boiler firing with various fuels, or they can be used in a combined cycle with a gas turbine and HRSG. Boiler emissions depend on the fuel used to generate the high-pressure steam to drive the steam turbine.

Instruments and Controls

Starting Systems. Unlike reciprocating engines and combustion turbines, steam turbines do not require auxiliary starting systems. Steam turbines are started through controlled opening of the main steam valve, which is in turn controlled by the turbine governing system. Larger turbines with multiple stages and/or dual shafting arrangements are started gradually to allow for controlled expansion and thermal stressing. Many of these turbines are provided with electrically powered turning gears that slowly rotate the shaft(s) during the initial stages of start-up.

Governing Systems. The wide variety of available governing systems allows a governor to be ideally matched to the characteristics of the driven machine and load profiles. The principal and most common function of a fixed-speed steam turbine governing system is to maintain constant turbine speed despite load fluctuations or minor variations in supply steam pressure. This arrangement assumes that close control of the output of the driven component, such as a generator in a power plant, is primary to plant operation, and that the generator can adjust its capacity to varying loads.

Often it is desirable to vary turbine speed in response to an external signal. In centrifugal water-chilling systems, for example, reduced speed generally reduces steam rate at partial load. An electric, electronic, or pneumatic device responds to the system load or temperature of fluid leaving the water-chilling heat exchanger (evaporator). To avoid compressor surge and optimize the steam rate, the speed is controlled initially down to some part load, then controlled in conjunction with the compressor's built-in capacity control (e.g., inlet vanes).

Process applications frequently require placing an external signal on the turbine governing system to reset the speed control point. External signals may be needed to maintain a fixed compressor discharge pressure, regardless of load or condenser water temperature variations. Plants relying on a closely maintained heat balance may control turbine speed to maintain an optimum pressure level of steam entering, being extracted from, or exhausting from the turbine. One

example is the combination turbine absorption plant, where control of pressure of the steam exhausting from the turbine (and feeding the absorption unit) is an integral part of the plant control system.

Components. The steam turbine governing system consists of (1) a speed governor (mechanical, hydraulic, electrical, or electronic), (2) a speed control mechanism (relays, servomotors, pressure- or power-amplifying devices, levers, and linkages), (3) governor-controlled valve(s), (4) a speed changer, and (5) external control devices, as required.

The **speed governor** responds directly to turbine speed and initiates action of the other parts of the governing system. The simplest speed governor is the direct-acting flyball, which depends on changes in centrifugal force for proper action. Capable of adjusting speeds through an approximate 20% range, it is widely used on single-stage, mechanical-drive steam turbines with speeds of up to 5000 rpm and steam pressure of up to 4 MPa (gage).

The most common speed governor for centrifugal water-chilling system turbines is the oil pump type. In its direct-acting form, oil pressure, produced by a pump either directly mounted on the turbine shaft or in some form responsive to turbine speed, actuates the inlet steam valve.

The oil relay hydraulic governor (Figure 39), has greater sensitivity and effective force. Here, the speed-induced oil pressure changes are amplified in a **servomotor** or **pilot-valve relay** to produce the motive effort required to reposition the steam inlet valve or valves.

The least expensive turbine has a single governor-controlled steam admission **throttle valve**, perhaps augmented by one or more small auxiliary valves (usually manually operated), which close off nozzles supplying the turbine steam chest for better part-load efficiency. Figure 40 shows the effect of auxiliary valves on part-load turbine performance.

For more precise speed governing and maximum efficiency without manual valve adjustment, multiple automatic nozzle control is used (Figure 41). Its principal application is in larger turbines where a single governor-controlled steam admission valve would be too large to allow sensitive control. The greater power required to actuate the multiple-valve mechanism dictates using hydraulic servomotors. **Speed changers** adjust the setting of the governing systems while the turbine is in operation. Usually, they comprise either a means of changing spring tension or a means of regulating oil flow

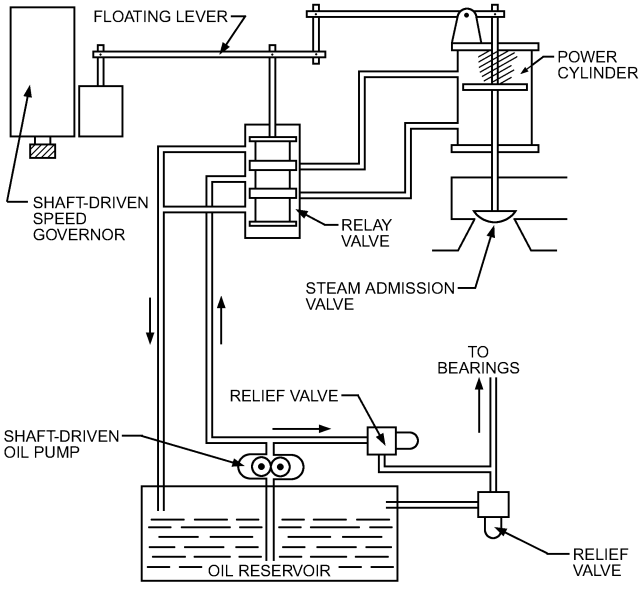


Fig. 39 Oil Relay Governor

Table 15 NEMA Classification of Speed Governors

Class of Governor	Range of Speed Changer Adjustment, %	Maximum Steady-State Speed Regulation, %	Maximum Speed Variation, % Plus or Minus	Maximum Speed Rise, %	Trip Speed, % Above Rated Speed
A	10 to 65	10	0.75	13	15
B	10 to 80	6	0.50	7	10
C	10 to 80	4	0.25	7	10
D	10 to 90	0.50	0.25	7	10

Source: NEMA *Standard* SM 24.

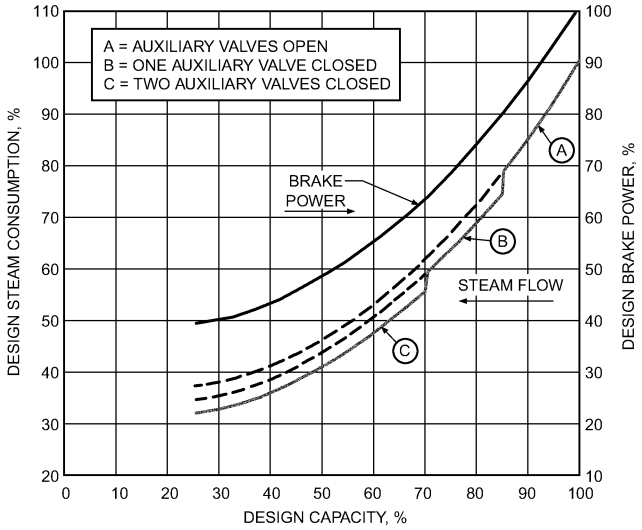


Fig. 40 Part-Load Turbine Performance Showing Effect of Auxiliary Valves

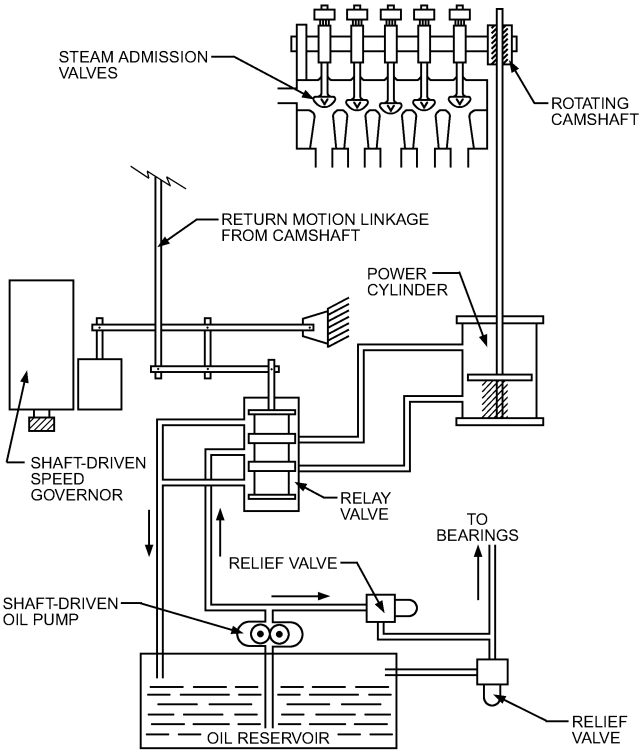


Fig. 41 Multivalve Oil Relay Governor

by a needle valve. The upper limit of a speed changer's capability should not exceed the rated turbine speed. These speed changers, though usually mounted on the turbine, may sometimes be remotely located at a central control point.

External control devices are often used when some function other than turbine speed is controlled. In such cases, a signal overrides the turbine speed governor's action, and the latter assumes a speed-limiting function. The external signal controls steam admission either by direct inlet valve positioning or by adjusting the speed governor setting. The valve-positioning method either exerts mechanical force on the valve-positioning mechanism or, if power has to be amplified, regulates the pilot valve in a hydraulic servomotor system.

Where more precise control is required, the speed governor adjusting method is preferred. Although the external signal continually resets the governor as required, the speed governor always provides ideal turbine speed control. Thus, it maintains the particular set speed, regardless of load or steam pressure variations.

Classification. The National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA) *Standard* SM 24 classifies steam turbine governors as shown in Table 15. **Range of speed changer adjustment**, expressed as a percentage of rated speed, is the range through which the turbine speed may be adjusted downward from rated speed by the speed changer, with the turbine operating under control of the speed governor and passing a steam flow equal to the flow at rated power, output, and speed. The range of the speed changer adjustment, expressed as a percentage of rated speed, is derived from the following equation:

$$\text{Range (\%)} = \frac{\text{(Rated speed)} - \text{(Minimum speed setting)}}{\text{Rated speed}} \times 100$$

Steady-state speed regulation, expressed as a percentage of rated speed, is the change in sustained speed when the power output of the turbine is gradually changed from rated power output to zero power output under the following conditions:

- Steam conditions (initial pressure, initial temperature, and exhaust pressure) are set at rated values and held constant.
- Speed changer is adjusted to give rated speed with rated power output.
- Any external control device is rendered inoperative and blocked open to allow free flow of steam to the governor-controlled valve(s).

The steady-state speed regulation is derived from the following equation:

$$\text{Regulation (\%)} = \frac{\left(\begin{array}{c}\text{Speed at zero}\\ \text{power output}\end{array}\right) - \left(\begin{array}{c}\text{Speed at rated}\\ \text{power output}\end{array}\right)}{\text{Speed at rated power output}} \times 100$$

Steady-state speed regulation of automatic extraction or mixed pressure turbines is derived with zero extraction or induction flow and with the pressure-regulating system(s) inoperative and blocked in the position corresponding to rated extraction or induction pressure(s) at rated power output.

Speed variation, expressed as a percentage of rated speed, is the total magnitude of speed change or fluctuations from the speed setting. It is defined as the difference in speed variation between the governing system in operation and the governing system blocked to be inoperative, with all other conditions constant. This characteristic includes dead band and sustained oscillations. Expressed as a percentage of rated speed, the speed variation is derived from the following equation:

$$\begin{array}{c}\text{Speed}\\ \text{variation (\%)}\end{array} = \frac{\left(\begin{array}{c}\text{Speed change}\\ \text{above set speed}\end{array}\right) - \left(\begin{array}{c}\text{Speed change}\\ \text{below set speed}\end{array}\right)}{\text{Rated speed}} \times 100$$

Dead band, also called **wander**, is a characteristic of the speed-governing system. It is the insensitivity of the speed-governing system and the total speed change during which the governing valve(s) do not change position to compensate for the speed change.

Stability is a measure of the speed-governing system's ability to position the governor-controlled valve(s); thus, sustained oscillations of speed are not produced during a sustained load demand or following a change to a new load demand. Speed oscillations, also called hunt, are characteristics of the speed-governing system. A governing system's ability to minimize sustained oscillations is measured by its stability.

Maximum speed rise, expressed as a percentage of rated speed, is the maximum momentary increase in speed obtained when the turbine is developing rated power output at rated speed and the load is suddenly and completely reduced to zero. The maximum speed rise, expressed as a percentage of rated speed, is derived from the following equation:

$$\text{Speed rise (\%)} = \frac{\left(\begin{array}{c}\text{Maximum speed at}\\ \text{zero power output}\end{array}\right) - \left(\begin{array}{c}\text{Rated}\\ \text{speed}\end{array}\right)}{\text{Rated speed}} \times 100$$

Protective Devices. In addition to speed-governing controls, certain safety devices are required on steam turbines. These include an overspeed mechanism, which acts through a quick-tripping valve independent of the main governor valve to shut off the steam supply to the turbine, and a pressure relief valve in the turbine casing. Overspeed trip devices may act directly, through linkages to close the steam valve, or hydraulically, by relieving oil pressure to allow the valve to close. Also, the turbine must shut down if other safety devices, such as oil pressure failure controls or any of the driven system's protective controls, so dictate. These devices usually act through an electrical interconnection to close the turbine trip valve mechanically or hydraulically. To shorten the coast-down time of a tripped condensing turbine, a vacuum breaker in the turbine exhaust opens to admit air on receiving the trip signal.

Operation and Maintenance

Maintenance requirements for steam turbines vary greatly with complexity of design, throttle pressure rating, duty cycle, and steam quality (both physical and chemical). Typically, several common factors can be attributed to operational problems with steam turbines. These include erosion of high-pressure turbine nozzle and blades by solid particles transported from steam lines, superheaters, or reheaters, especially during cycling operation, that weakens rotating blades; fouling of high-pressure turbine with copper deposits (in case of mixed metallurgy of feedwater train); and stress corrosion cracking and corrosion fatigue of low-pressure turbine. The latter failures occur during both steady-state and cycling operation and are attributed to formation of early condensate in the so-called phase transition region where steam changes from superheated to saturated condition. The concentration of impurities in the early condensate is higher than in the steam that enters the turbine. Early condensate droplets may precipitate on blade surface and form liquid films, which can evaporate during flow and form the highly concentrated solutions on the surfaces inside turbines. The level of corrosive impurities in these films may be much higher than in the early condensate. In addition, steam moisture may result in water droplet erosion and, in combination with other parameters, flow-accelerated corrosion.

The best way to minimize both corrosion and erosion in steam turbines is to maintain proper feedwater boiler and steam chemistry. The requirements to cycle chemistry are more stringent with steam pressure. To protect steam turbines from unnecessary damage, the level of impurities in the steam from the boiler or HRSG must be kept within the limits specified by corresponding cycle chemistry guidelines.

Turbines subject to cyclical operation should be examined carefully every 18 to 36 months. Usually, nondestructive testing is used to establish material loss trends and predictable maintenance requirements for sustained planned outages.

Turbine seals, glands, and bearings are also common areas of deterioration and maintenance. Bearings require frequent examination, especially in cyclical duty systems. Oil samples from the lubrication system should be taken regularly to determine concentration of solid particle contamination and changes in viscous properties. Filters and oil should be recycled according to manufacturers' recommendations and the operational history of the turbine system.

Large multistage steam turbines usually contain instrumentation that monitors vibration within the casing. As deposits build on blades, blade material erodes or corrodes; as mechanical tolerance of bearing surfaces increases, nonuniform rotation increases turbine vibration. Vibration instrumentation, consequently, is used to determine maintenance intervals for turbines, especially those subject to extensive base-load operations where visual examination is not feasible.

5.2 ORGANIC RANKINE CYCLES

Organic Rankine cycle (ORC) technology is based on the Rankine process, except that instead of water/steam, an organic working fluid is used. ORCs can convert high- or low-quality thermal energy into useful mechanical or electrical energy and thus improve the efficiency of integrated energy systems by using waste heat from DG equipment. One challenge with ORCs is that their inherent thermal conversion (Carnot) efficiency is very low for lower-quality thermal sources. However, this disadvantage is offset by the fact that the fuel is energy that would otherwise be wasted.

ORCs began to be studied and applied as energy conversion engines over 100 years ago to use low-grade heat from geothermal waters, solar energy from liquid and vapor collectors, industrial waste heat, biomass combustion, etc.

ORCs are used for low-temperature waste heat recovery, efficiency improvement in power stations, and recovery of geothermal and solar heat. Small-scale ORCs have been used commercially or as pilot plants. About 30 commercial ORC plants were built before 1984 with an output of 100 kW. ORCs allow efficient exploitation of low-temperature heat sources to produce electricity in a wide range of power outputs, from a few kilowatts to 3 MW. Several organic compounds have been used in ORCs (e.g., CFCs, halocarbons, iso-pentane, ammonia) to match the temperature of available waste heat sources. Efficiency is estimated to be between 10 and 30%, depending on operating temperatures.

5.3 EXPANSION ENGINES/TURBINES

Expansion turbines use compressed gases available from gas-producing processes to produce shaft power. One application expands natural gas from high-pressure pipelines in much the same way that a steam turbine replaces a pressure-reducing valve. These engines are used mainly, however, for cryogenic applications to about –195°C (e.g., oxygen for steel mills, low-temperature chemical processes, the space program). Relatively high-pressure air or gas expanded in an engine drives a piston and is cooled in the process. At the shaft, about 60 kJ/kW is removed. Available units, developing as much as 450 kW, handle flows ranging from 0.5 to 5 m^3/s. Throughput at a given pressure is controlled by varying the cutoff point, engine speed, or both. The conversion efficiency of heat energy to shaft work ranges from 65 to 85%. A 5-to-1 pressure ratio and an inlet pressure of 21 MPa (gage) are recommended. Outlet temperatures as low as 5.5 K have been handled satisfactorily.

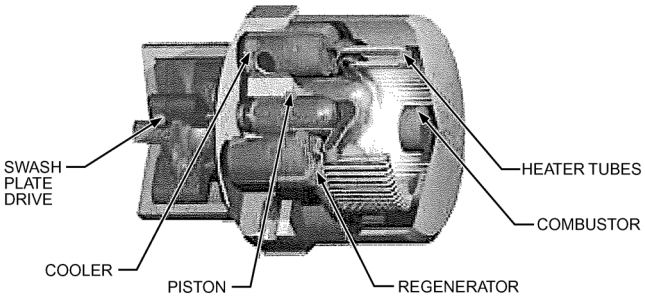


Fig. 42 Cutaway Core of a Kinematic Stirling Engine

This process consumes no fuel, but it does provide shaft energy, as well as expansion refrigeration, which fits the definition of CHP. Similarly, a back-pressure steam turbine, used instead of a pressure-reducing valve, generates productive shaft power and allows use of the residual thermal energy.

Natural gas from a high-pressure pipeline can be run through a turbine to produce shaft energy and then burned downstream. See the section on Combustion Turbines for more information.

5.4 STIRLING ENGINES

Stirling-cycle engines were patented in 1816 and were commonly used before World War I. They were popular because they had a better safety record than steam engines and used air as the working fluid. As steam engines improved and the competing compact Otto-cycle engine was invented, Stirling engines lost favor. Recent attention to distributed energy resources (DER), used by the space and marine industries, has revived interest in Stirling engines and increased research and development efforts.

Stirling engines, classified as external combustion engines, are sealed systems with an inert, reusable working fluid (either helium or hydrogen). Rather than burning fuel inside the cylinder, the engine uses external heat to expand the gas contained inside the cylinder and push against its pistons. The engine then recycles the same captive working fluid by cooling and compressing it, then reheating it to expand and drive the pistons, which in turn drive a generator. These engines are generally found in small sizes (1 to 55 kW). The maximum Carnot efficiency based on the second law of thermodynamics $[1 - (T_{cold}/T_{hot})]$ for a heat source of 970°C and a cold sink of 25°C is approximately 74%. Overall, electrical efficiency of these engines are usually in the range of 12 to 30% (difference is due to friction losses and heat transfer ineffectiveness); overall efficiency in a combined heat and power mode is around 80%.

Types

Stirling engines can be divided into two major types: kinematic and free-piston engines (NREL 2003).

Kinematic Stirling Engines. Pistons of these engines are connected by rods and crankshaft or with a wobble plate (also known as a swash plate). The wobble plate allows for variable output while maintaining thermal input, allowing faster response to changes in demand (Figure 42).

Kinematic Stirling engines can be designed as either single- or double-acting engines. Single-acting kinematic Stirling engines can have one or more cylinders with varying designs for mechanical linkage. Double-acting kinematic engines require several cylinders.

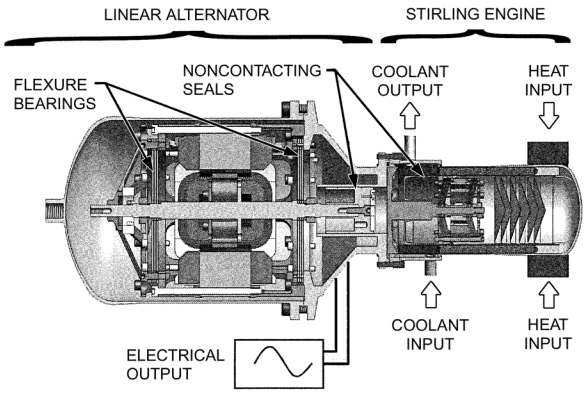


Fig. 43 Cutaway Core of a Free-Piston Stirling Engine

(Courtesy Infinia Corporation)

The working fluid in a double-acting system operates on opposite sides of the piston.

Free-Piston Stirling Engines. These engines do not have any mechanical coupling between the piston and the power output. The pistons are mounted in flexures and oscillate freely (Figure 43). Flexures are springs that are flexible in the axial direction, but very stiff in the radial direction. A fluid or a linear alternator receives the reciprocating output via pneumatic transfer. Free-piston Stirling engines are single-acting, with the working fluid only operating on one side of a piston. Free-piston configurations are limited to sizes less than 12.5 kW.

Performance Characteristics

Most manufacturers promoting Stirling engines for distributed generation do not yet offer a standard product line. Although Stirling engines work on simple principles, designers are faced with challenges in determining design tradeoffs between complexity, cost, durability/reliability, and efficiency. The main difficulties with recent Stirling engines are their long-term durability/reliability and high cost. Durability concerns for Stirling engines include the following:

- Shaft seals separating the high-pressure hydrogen space from lubrication in the mechanical drive train
- Low-leakage piston rings and bearings for operation in the unlubricated working engine space
- Minimizing material stress and corrosion in the high-temperature, high-pressure heater head, which must operate at internal conditions of >700°C
- Blockage of fine-meshed heat matrices used in regenerator assemblies by particles generated by rubbing piston rings

Although these problems have delayed adoption of Stirling engine technology, run times are beginning to approach acceptable lengths for some distributed power applications. The electrical efficiency of current engines is approximately 27% HHV (30% LHV).

Fuel Systems

Stirling engines absorb heat from a wide range of fuel sources (e.g., natural gas, propane, oil, biomass, waste fuels) and convert it to electricity with minimal emissions and low maintenance requirements. Typical heat sources include standard gaseous and liquid fuels, with options to accept low-heating-value landfill and digester gas, petroleum flare gas, and other low-grade gaseous, liquid, and solid waste fuels. Raw heat from solar concentrators or flue gas stacks can also be converted to electricity, with no fuel costs and no incremental emissions.

Stirling engines usually require a heat source ranging between 815 and 980°C.

Contaminants are a concern with some waste fuels, particularly acid gas components such as hydrogen sulfide (H_2S content should be less than 7%).

Power Systems

Fuel flexibility of these engines makes them candidates for use as heat recovery units in industrial processes. These engines generally require a heat source between 815 and 980°C, noncorrosive, and relatively free of particulates. Their electric efficiencies are approximately 30% (based on LHV), leaving approximately 70% of the heat input to be rejected in the cooling system and exhaust gases. As with any combustion system, there performance drops as elevation increases, because of density changes in the fuel and combustion air.

Part-load operation is a design trade-off issue. Devices designed for distributed generation applications are usually capable of a 3:1 turn-down.

Exhaust Systems

The combustor of a Stirling engine can be customized to achieve low emissions. With a hot-end operating temperature of 870°C, the combustor needs to operate only a few hundred degrees hotter, which puts it in the lower end of the thermal NO_x formation range. NO_x-reducing techniques are available, such as lean burn, staged combustion, or flue gas recirculation. NO_x emissions improve at part load because of lower combustor temperatures. When firing with natural gas, SO_x should not be an issue.

Coolant Systems

Stirling engines usually convert approximately 30% of heat input to electric power, with almost 50% going to the coolant and the rest dissipated as exhaust or other losses. Because Stirling engines are liquid-cooled, it is relatively easy to capture the low-temperature waste heat for CHP applications (thermal output of approximately 60°C) such as water heating or other low-temperature heating applications. The addition of a heat exchanger (with related controls) is the only difference between a power-only unit and CHP unit. Power-only units are usually equipped with a radiator and fan to dissipate coolant heat into the environment.

Operation and Maintenance

Maintenance procedures and associated costs have not yet been developed because of the lack of long-term operating experience. The engine is usually designed for a 40 000 h life. The engine would be replaced at the end of this period. Periodic maintenance after 8000 h usually includes oil and oil filter and air filter changes. Another important maintenance item is working fluid makeup: the engine operates at a relatively high working pressure, and the small molecular size of the working fluid means it can leak through the engine seals. Occasional working fluid injection may be required. Economic life of these systems is estimated to be around 10 years.

6. THERMAL-TO-THERMAL COMPONENTS

6.1 THERMAL OUTPUT CHARACTERISTICS

By definition, CHP systems use the fuel energy in the form of thermal energy that the prime mover does not convert into shaft energy. If site heat energy requirements can be met effectively by the thermal by-product at the level it is available from the prime mover, this salvaged heat reduces the normal fuel requirements of the site and increase overall plant efficiency. The ability to use prime mover waste heat determines overall system efficiency and is one of the critical factors in economic feasibility.

This section describes devices that convert prime mover "waste" thermal energy into energy streams suited to meet typical thermal loads. The section begins with a description of the thermal output characteristics and heat recovery opportunities of key prime movers.

Reciprocating Engines

In all reciprocating internal combustion engines except small air-cooled units, heat can be reclaimed from the jacket cooling system, lubricating system, turbochargers, exhaust, and aftercoolers. These engines require extensive cooling to remove excess heat not conducted into the power train during combustion and the heat resulting from friction. Coolant fluids and lubricating oil are circulated to remove this engine heat.

Waste heat in the form of hot water or low-pressure steam is recovered from the engine jacket manifolds and exhaust, and additional heat can be recovered from the lubrication system (see Figures 46 to 50).

Provisions similar to those used with gas turbines are necessary if supplemental heat is required, except an engine exhaust is rarely fired with a booster because it contains insufficient oxygen. If electrical supplemental heat is used, the additional electrical load is reflected back to the prime mover, which reacts accordingly by producing additional waste heat. This action creates a feedback effect, which can stabilize system operation under certain conditions. The approximate distribution of input fuel energy under selective control of the thermal demand for an engine operating at rated load is as follows:

Shaft power	33%
Convection and radiation	7%
Rejected in jacket water	30%
Rejected in exhaust	30%

These amounts vary with engine load and design. Four-cycle engine heat balances for naturally aspirated (Figure 44) and turbocharged gas engines (Figure 45) show typical heat distribution. The exhaust gas temperature for these engines is about 650°C at full load and 540°C at 60% load.

Two-cycle lower-speed (900 rpm and below) engines operate at lower exhaust gas temperatures, particularly at light loads, because the scavenger air volumes remain high through the entire range of capacity. High-volume, lower-temperature exhaust gas offers less efficient exhaust gas heat recovery possibilities. The exhaust gas temperature is approximately 370°C at full load and drops below 260°C at low loads.

Combustion Turbines

In the gas turbine cycle, the average fuel-to-electrical-shaft efficiency ranges from approximately 12% to above 35%, with the rest of the fuel energy discharged in the exhaust and through radiation or internal coolants in large turbines. A minimum stack exhaust temperature of about 150°C is required to prevent condensation. Because the heat rate efficiency is lower, the quantity of heat recoverable per unit of power is greater for a gas turbine than for a reciprocating engine. This heat is generally available at the higher temperature of the exhaust gas. The net result is an overall thermal efficiency of 50% and higher. Because gas turbine exhaust contains a large percentage of excess air (high O_2 content), afterburners or boost burners may be installed in the exhaust to create a supplementary boiler system or to cofire an absorption chiller. This system can provide additional steam, or level the steam production or cooling during reduced turbine loads. Absorption chillers able to operate directly off turbine exhausts (exhaust-fired absorption chillers) with coefficients of performance (COPs) of 1.30 or more are also available. The COP is the cooling energy output divided by energy input. The conventional method of controlling steam or hot-water production in a heat recovery system at part load is to bypass some exhaust gases around the boiler tubes and out the exhaust stack through a gas bypass valve assembly.

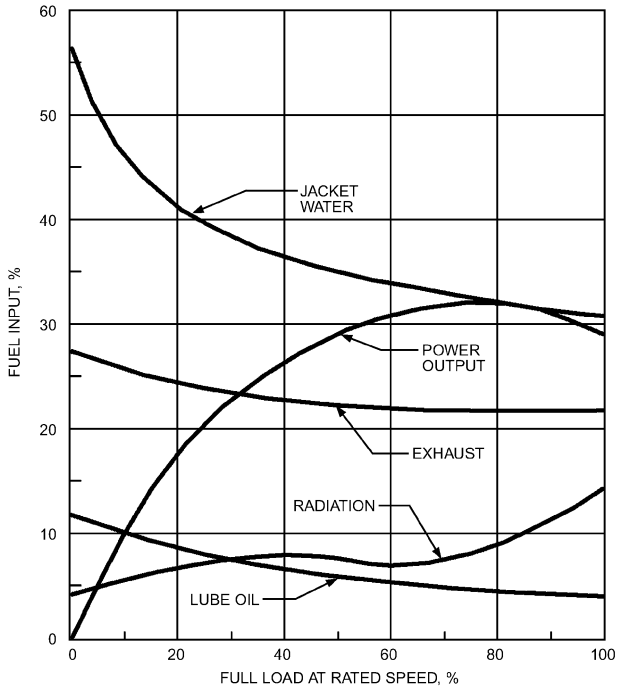


Fig. 44 Heat Balance for Naturally Aspirated Engine

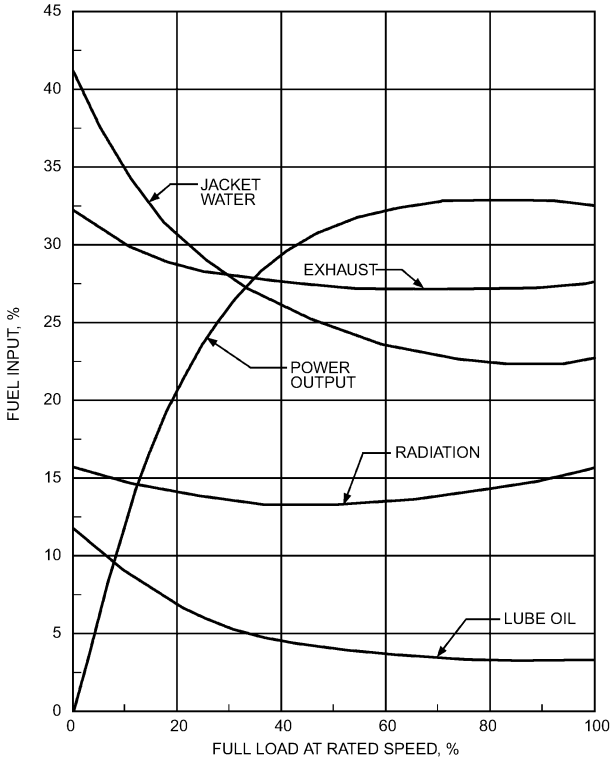


Fig. 45 Heat Balance for Turbocharged Engine

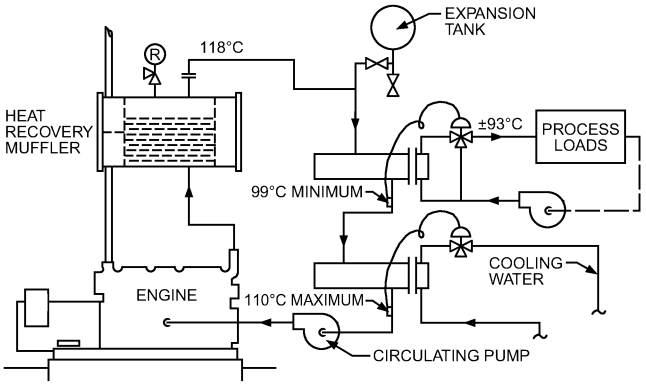


Fig. 46 Hot-Water Heat Recovery

6.2 HEAT RECOVERY

Reciprocating Engines

Engine Jacket Heat Recovery. Engine jacket cooling passages for reciprocating engines, including the water-cooling circuits in the block, heads, and exhaust manifolds, must remove about 30% of the heat input to the engine. If the machine operates above 82°C coolant temperature, condensation of combustion products should produce no ill effects. Some engines have modified gaskets and seals to enable satisfactory operation up to 120°C at 200 kPa. Keeping temperature rise through the jacket to less than 8 K helps avoid thermal stress. Keep flow rates within engine manufacturers' design limits to avoid erosion from excessive flow or inadequate distribution in the engine from low flow rates.

Engine-mounted water-circulating pumps driven from an auxiliary shaft can be modified with proper shaft seals and bearings to give good service life at elevated temperatures. Configurations that have a circulating pump for each engine increase reliability because the remaining engines can operate if one engine pump assembly fails. An alternative design uses an electric-drive pump battery to circulate water to several engines and has a standby pump assembly in reserve, interconnected so that any engine or pump can be cut off without disabling the jacket water system.

Forced-circulation hot water at 120°C and 200 kPa (gage), can be used for many loads, including water-heating systems for comfort and process loads, absorption refrigeration chillers, desiccant dehumidifiers, and service water heating. Engine jacket coolant distribution must be limited to reduce the risk of leaks, contamination, or other failures in downstream equipment that could prevent engine cooling.

One solution is to confine each engine circuit to its individual engine, using a heat exchanger to transfer salvaged heat to another circuit that serves several engines through an extensive distribution system. An additional heat exchanger is needed in each engine circuit to remove heat whenever the waste heat recovery circuit does not extract all the heat produced (Figure 46). This approach is highly reliable, but because the salvage circuit must be at a lower temperature than the engine operating level, it requires either larger heat exchangers, piping, and pumps or a sacrifice of system efficiency that might result from these lower temperatures.

Low-temperature limit controls prevent excessive system heat loads from overloading the system and seriously reducing the engines' operating temperature, which could cause the engine casings to crack. A heat storage tank is an excellent buffer, because it can provide a high rate of heat for short periods to protect machinery serving the heat loads. The heat level can be controlled with supplementary input, such as an auxiliary boiler.

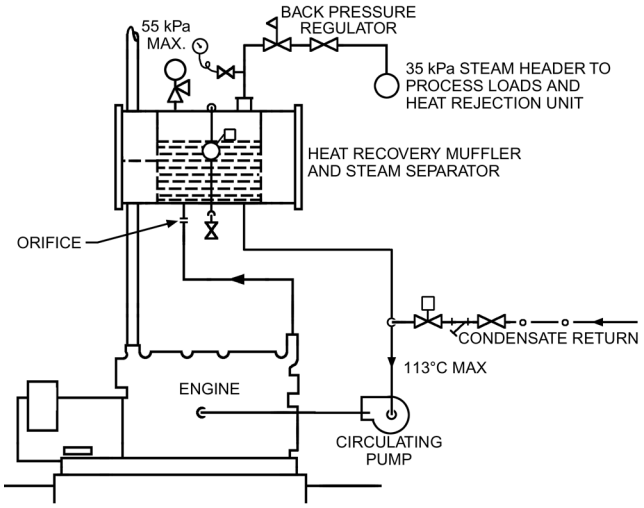


Fig. 47 Hot-Water Engine Cooling with Steam Heat Recovery (Forced Recirculation)

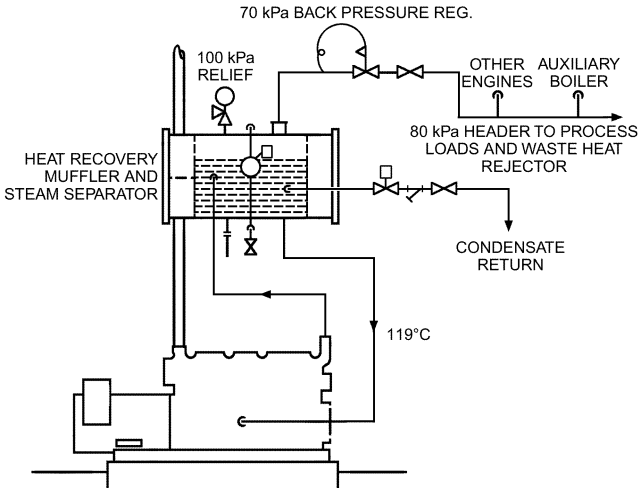


Fig. 48 Engine Cooling with Gravity Circulation and Steam Heat Recovery

A limited distribution system that distributes steam through nearby heat exchangers can salvage heat without contaminating the main engine cooling system (Figures 47 and 48). The salvage heat temperature is kept high enough for most low-pressure steam loads. Returning condensate must be treated to prevent engine oxidation. The flash tank can accumulate the sediment from treatment chemicals.

Lubricant Heat Recovery. Lubricant heat exchangers should keep oil temperatures at 88°C, with the highest coolant temperature consistent with economical use of the salvaged heat. Engine manufacturers usually size oil cooler heat transfer surfaces based on 54°C entering coolant water, without provision for additional lubricant heat gains from high engine operating temperatures. Compare the cost of a reliable supply of lower-temperature cooling water with that of increasing the oil-cooling heat exchanger size and using cooling water at 74°C. If engine jacket coolant temperatures are above 105°C and heat at 68 to 74°C can be used, heat from the lubricant can be recovered profitably.

The coolant should not foul the oil cooling heat exchanger. Untreated water should not be used unless it is free of silt, calcium

carbonates, sand, and other contaminants. A good solution is a closed-circuit, treated water system using an air-cooled heat transfer coil with freeze-protected coolant. A domestic water heater can be installed on the closed circuit to act as a reserve heat exchanger and to salvage some useful heat when needed. Inlet air temperatures are not as critical with diesel engines as with turbocharged natural gas engines, and aftercooler water on diesel engines can be run in series with the oil cooler (Figure 49). A double-tube heat exchanger can also be used to prevent contamination from a leaking tube.

Turbocharger Heat Recovery. Natural gas engine turbochargers need medium fuel gas pressure (80 to 140 kPa) and low aftercooler water temperatures (32°C or less) for high compression ratios and best fuel economy. Aftercooler water at 32°C is a premium coolant in many applications, because usual sources are raw domestic water and evaporative cooling systems such as cooling towers. Aftercooler water as warm as 57°C can be used, although this derates the engine. Using domestic water may be expensive because (1) coolant is continuously needed while the engine is running, and (2) available heat exchanger designs require a lot of water even though the load is less than 80 W/W (280 kJ/kWh). A cooling tower can be used, but it can increase initial costs; it also requires freeze protection and water quality control. If a cooling tower is used, the lubricant cooling load must be included in the tower design load for periods when there is no use for salvage lubricant heat.

Exhaust Gas Heat Recovery. Almost all heat transferred to the engine jacket cooling system can be reclaimed in a standard jacket cooling process or in combination with exhaust gas heat recovery. However, only part of the exhaust heat can be salvaged because of the limitations of heat transfer equipment and the need to prevent flue gas condensation (Figure 50).

Energy balances are often based on standard air at 15°C; however, exhaust temperature cannot easily be reduced to this level.

A minimum exhaust temperature of 120°C was established by the Diesel Engine Manufacturers Association (DEMA). Many heat recovery boiler designs are based on a minimum exhaust temperature of 150°C to avoid condensation and acid formation in the exhaust piping. Final exhaust temperature at part load is important for generator sets that frequently operate at part load. Depending on the initial exhaust temperature, about 50 to 60% of the available exhaust heat can be recovered.

A complete heat recovery system, which includes jacket water, lubricant, turbocharger, and exhaust, can increase the overall thermal efficiency from 30% for the engine generator alone to approximately 75%. Exhaust heat recovery equipment is available in the same categories as standard fire-tube and water-tube boilers.

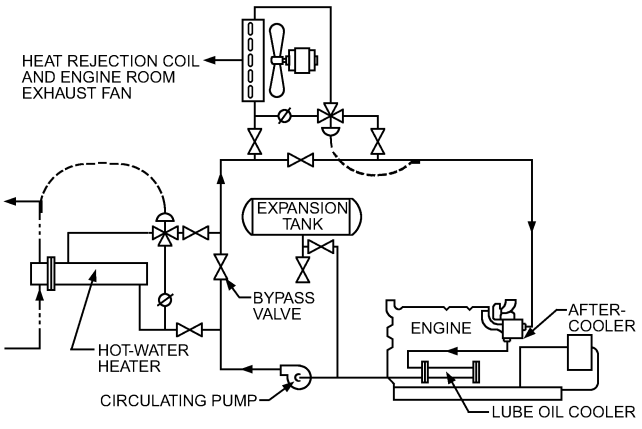


Fig. 49 Lubricant and Aftercooler System

Other heat recovery silencers and boilers include coil-type water heaters with integral silencers, water-tube boilers with steam separators for gas turbine, and engine exhausts and steam separators for high-temperature cooling of engine jackets. Recovery boiler design should facilitate inspection and cleaning of the exhaust gas and water sides of the heat transfer surface. Diesel engine units should have a means of soot removal, because soot deposits can quickly reduce heat exchanger effectiveness (Figure 51). These recovery boilers can also serve other requirements of the heat recovery system, such as surge tanks, steam separators, and fluid level regulators.

In many applications for heat recovery equipment, the demand for heat requires some method of **automatic control**. In vertical recovery boilers, control can be achieved by varying the water level in the boiler. Figure 52 shows a control system using an air-operated pressure controller with diaphragm or bellows control valves. When steam production begins to exceed demand, the feed control valve begins to close, throttling the feedwater supply. Concurrently, the dump valve begins to open, and the valves reach an equilibrium position that maintains a level in the boiler to match the steam demand.

This system can be fitted with an overriding exhaust temperature controller that regulates boiler output to maintain a preset minimum exhaust temperature at the outlet. This type of automatic control is limited to vertical boilers because the ASME (2004) *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* does not allow horizontal boilers to be controlled by varying the water level. Instead, a control condenser, radiator, or thermal storage can be used to absorb excess steam production.

In hot-water units, a temperature-controlled bypass valve can divert the water or exhaust gas to achieve automatic modulation with heat load demand (Figure 53). If water is diverted, precautions must be taken to limit the temperature rise of the lower flow of water in the recovery device, which could otherwise cause steaming. Heat recovery equipment should not adversely affect the primary func-

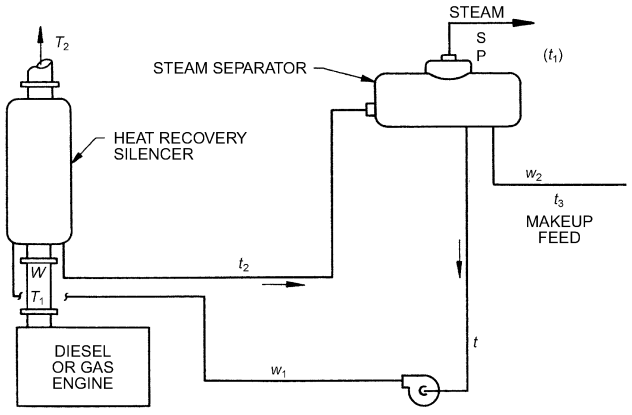


Fig. 50 Exhaust Heat Recovery with Steam Separator

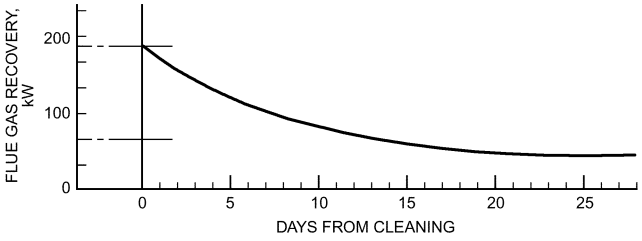


Fig. 51 Effect of Soot on Energy Recovery from Flue Gas Recovery Unit on Diesel Engine

tion of the engine to produce work. Therefore, design of waste heat recovery boilers should begin by determining the back pressure imposed on engine exhaust gas flow. Limiting back pressures vary widely with the make of engine, but the typical value is 1.5 kPa (gage). The next step is to calculate the heat transfer area that gives the most economical heat recovery without reducing the final exhaust temperature below 150°C.

Heat recovery silencers are designed to adapt to all engines; efficient heat recovery depends on the **initial exhaust temperature**. Most designs can be modified by adding or deleting heat transfer surface to suit the initial exhaust conditions and to maximize heat recovery down to a minimum temperature of 150°C.

Figure 54 shows the effect of lowering exhaust temperature below 150°C. This curve is based on a specific heat recovery silencer design with an initial exhaust temperature of 540°C. Lowering the final temperature from 150°C to 94°C increases heat recovery 14% but requires a 28% surface increase. Similarly, a reduction from 150°C to 40°C increases heat recovery 29% but requires a 120% surface increase. Therefore, the cost of heat transfer surface must be considered when determining the final temperature.

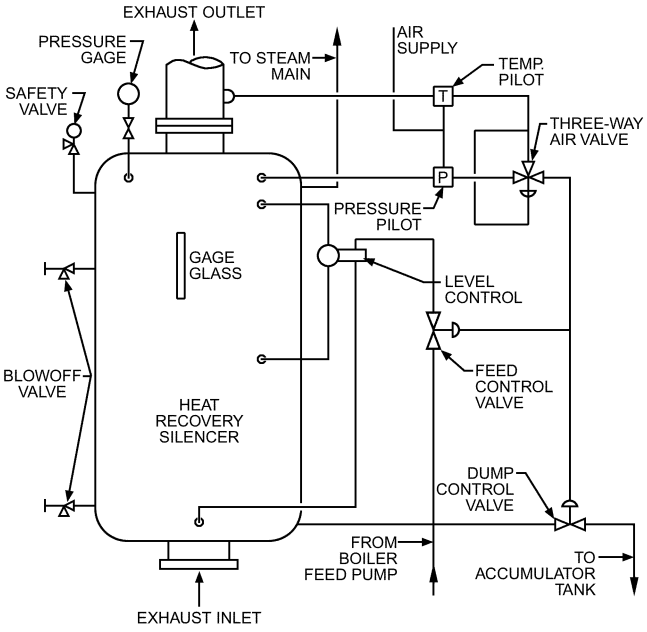


Fig. 52 Automatic Boiler System with Overriding Exhaust Temperature Control

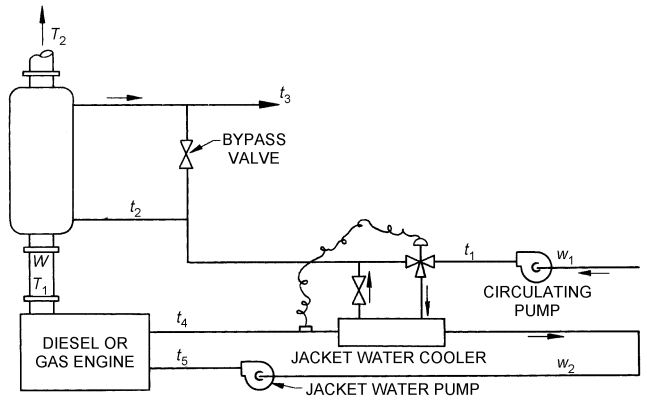


Fig. 53 Combined Exhaust and Jacket Water Heat Recovery System

Another factor to consider is water vapor condensation and acid formation if exhaust gas temperature falls below the dew point. This point varies with fuel and atmospheric conditions and is usually in the range of 50 to 65°C. This gives an adequate margin of safety for the 120°C minimum temperature recommended by DEMA. Also, it allows for other conditions that could cause condensation, such as an uninsulated boiler shell or other cold surface in the exhaust system, or part loads on an engine.

The quantity of water vapor varies with the type of fuel and the intake air humidity. Methane fuel, under ideal conditions and with only the correct amount of air for complete combustion, produces 2.25 kg of water vapor for every kilogram of methane burned. Similarly, diesel fuel produces 1.38 kg of water vapor per kilogram of fuel. In the gas turbine cycle, these relationships would not hold true because of the large quantities of excess air. Condensates formed at low exhaust temperatures can be highly acidic. Sulfuric acid from diesel fuels and carbonic acid from natural gas fuels can cause severe corrosion in the exhaust stack as well as in colder sections of the recovery device.

If engine exhaust flow and temperature data are available, and maximum recovery to 150°C final exhaust temperature is desired, the basic **exhaust recovery equation** is

$$q = m_e(c_p)_e(t_e - t_f) \quad (4)$$

where

q = heat recovered, kW
m_e = mass flow rate of exhaust, kg/s
t_e = exhaust temperature, °C
t_f = final exhaust temperature, °C
$(c_p)_e$ = specific heat of exhaust gas = 1.05 kJ/(kg·K)

Table 16 Temperatures Normally Required for Various Heating Applications

Application	Temperature, °C
Absorption refrigeration machines	90 to 120
Space heating	50 to 120
Water heating (domestic)	50 to 93
Process heating	66 to 120
Evaporation (water)	90 to 120
Residual fuel heating	100 to 165
Auxiliary power producers, with steam turbines or binary expanders	90 to 175

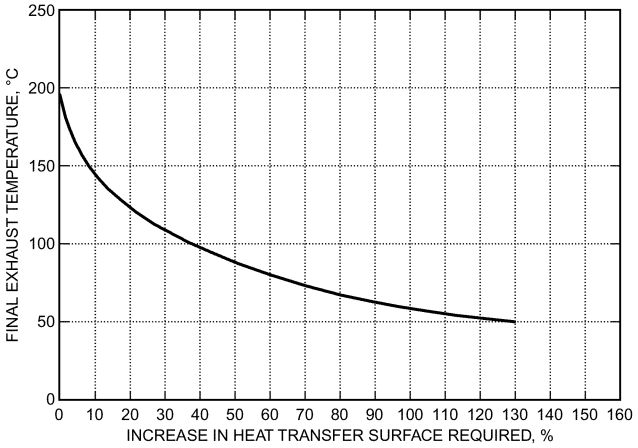


Fig. 54 Effect of Lowering Exhaust Temperature below 150°C

Table 17 Full-Load Exhaust Mass Flows and Temperatures for Various Engines

Type of Four-Cycle Engine	Mass Flow, g/(kW·s)	Temperature, °C
Naturally aspirated gas	1.5	650
Turbocharged gas	1.7	650
Naturally aspirated diesel	2.0	400
Turbocharged diesel	2.2	450
Gas turbine, nonregenerative	3.0 to 8.1*	430 to 570*

*Lower mass flows correspond to more efficient gas turbines.

Exhaust recovery equation applies to both steam and hot water units. To estimate the quantity of steam obtainable, the total heat recovered q is divided by the latent heat of steam at the desired pressure. The latent heat value should include an allowance for the temperature of the feedwater return to the boiler. The basic equation is

$$q = m_s(h_s - h_f) \tag{5}$$

where

m_s = mass flow rate of steam, kg/s
h_s = enthalpy of steam, kJ/kg
h_f = enthalpy of feedwater, kJ/kg

Similarly, the quantity of hot water can be determined by

$$q = m_w (c_p)_w(t_o - t_i) \tag{6}$$

where

m_w = mass flow rate of water, kg/s
$(c_p)_w$ = specific heat of water = 4.8 kJ/(kg·K)
t_o = temperature of water out, °C
t_i = temperature of input water, °C

If shaft power is known but engine data are not, heat available from the exhaust is about 400 J per kilowatt-hour output. The exhaust recovery equations also apply to gas turbines, although the flow rate is much greater. The estimate for gas turbine boilers is 3 to 4 kJ per kilowatt-hour output. These values are reasonably accurate for steam pressures in the range of 100 to 1000 kPa (gage).

Normal procedure is to design and fabricate heat recovery boilers to the ASME (2004) *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* (Section VIII) for the working pressure required. Because temperatures in most exhaust systems are not excessive, it is common to use flange or firebox-quality steels for pressure parts and low-carbon steels for the nonpressure components. Wrought iron or copper can be used for extended-fin surfaces to improve heat transfer capacities.

In special applications such as sewage gas engines, where exhaust products are highly corrosive, wrought iron or special steels are used to improve corrosion resistance. Exhaust heat may be used to make steam, or it may be used directly for drying or other processes. The steam provides space heating, hot water, and absorption refrigeration, which may supply air conditioning and process refrigeration. Heat recovery systems generally involve equipment specifically tailored for the job, although conventional fire-tube boilers are sometimes used. Exhaust heat may be recovered from reciprocating engines by a muffler-type exhaust heat recovery unit. Table 16 gives the temperatures normally required for various heat recovery applications.

In some engines, exhaust heat rejection exceeds jacket water rejection. Generally, gas engine exhaust temperatures run from 370 to 650°C, as shown in Table 17. About 50 to 75% of the sensible heat in the exhaust may be considered recoverable. The economics of exhaust heat boiler design often limits the temperature differential between exhaust gas and generated steam to a minimum of 55 K. Therefore, in low-pressure steam boilers, gas temperature can be reduced to 150 to 175°C; the corresponding final exhaust temperature range in high-pressure steam boilers is 200 to 260°C.

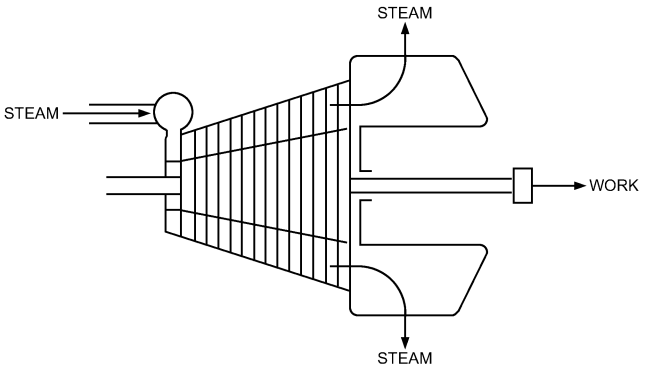


Fig. 55 Back-Pressure Turbine

Because they require higher airflows to purge their cylinders, two-cycle engines have lower temperatures than four-cycle engines, and thus are less desirable for heat recovery. Gas turbines have even larger flow rates, but at high enough temperatures to make heat recovery worthwhile when the recovered heat can be efficiently used.

Combustion Turbines

The information in the section on Exhaust Gas Heat Recovery applies to combustion turbines as well.

Steam Turbines

Noncondensing Turbines. The back-pressure or noncondensing turbine is the simplest turbine. It consists of a turbine in which steam is exhausted at atmospheric pressure or higher. They are generally used when there is a process need for high-pressure steam, and all steam condensation takes place downstream of the turbine cycle and in the process. Figure 55 shows the steam path for a noncondensing turbine. The back-pressure steam turbine operates on the enthalpy difference between steam inlet and exhaust conditions. The noncondensing turbine's Carnot cycle efficiency tends to be lower than is possible with other turbines because the difference between turbine inlet and exhaust temperatures tends to be lower. Because much of the steam's heat, including the latent heat of vaporization, is exhausted and then used in a process, the back-pressure CHP system process or total energy efficiency can be very high. One application for back-pressure turbines is as a substitute for pressure-reducing valves; they provide the same function (pressure regulation), but also produce a useful product (power).

The back-pressure turbine has one major disadvantage in CHP: because the process load is the heat sink for the steam, the amount of steam passed through the turbine depends on the heat load at the site. Thus, the back-pressure turbine provides little flexibility in directly matching electrical output to electrical requirements; electrical output is controlled by the thermal load. Direct linkage of site steam requirements and electrical output can result in electric utility charges for standby service or increased supplemental service unless some measures are taken to increase system flexibility.

Figure 56 shows several ways to achieve flexible performance when electrical and thermal loads do not match the back-pressure turbine's capability. Figure 56A shows the basic arrangement of a noncondensing steam turbine and its relationship to the facility. Figure 56B shows the addition of a pressure-reducing valve (PRV) to bypass some or all of the steam around the turbine. Thus, if the process steam demand exceeds the turbine's capability, the additional steam can be provided through the PRV. Figure 56C shows use of a load condenser to allow electricity generation, even when there is no process steam demand. These techniques to match

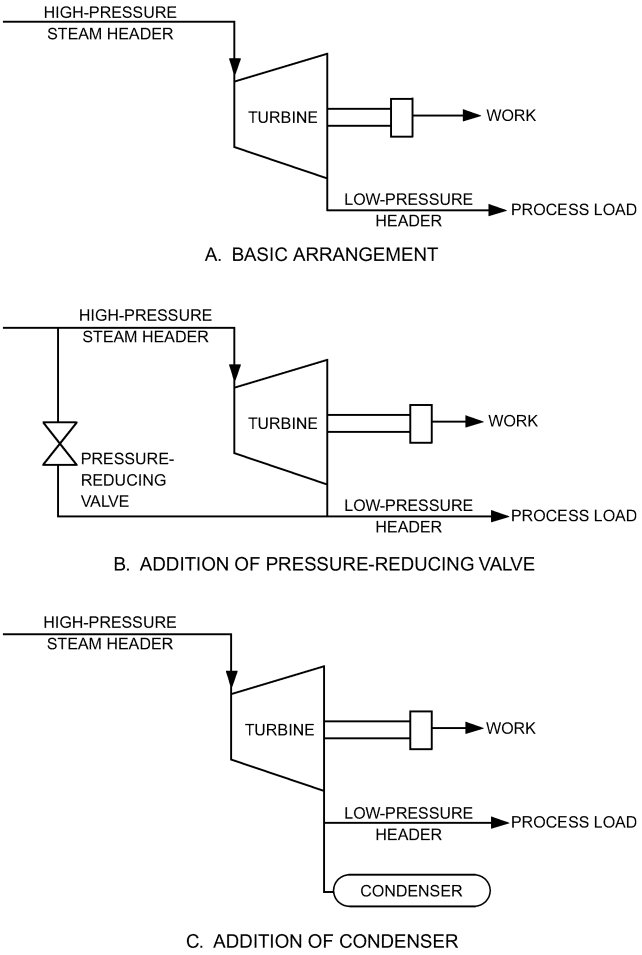


Fig. 56 Integration of Back-Pressure Turbine with Facility

thermal and electrical loads are very inefficient, and operating time at these off-design conditions must be minimized by careful analysis of the coincident, time-varying process steam and electrical demands.

Process heat recovered from the noncondensing turbine can be easily estimated using steam tables combined with knowledge of the steam flow, steam inlet conditions, steam exit pressure, and turbine isentropic efficiency.

Extraction Turbines. Figure 57 shows the internal arrangement of an automatic extraction turbine that exhausts steam at one or more stations along the steam flow path. Conceptually, the extraction turbine is a hybrid of condensing and noncondensing turbines. Its advantage is that it allows extraction of the quantity of steam required at each temperature or pressure needed by the industrial process. Multiple extraction ports allow great flexibility in matching the CHP cycle to thermal requirements at the site. Extracted steam can also be used in the power cycle for feedwater heating or powerhouse pumps. Depending on cycle constraints and process requirements, the extraction turbine's final exit conditions can be either back-pressure or condensing.

A diaphragm in the automatic extraction turbine separates the high- and low-pressure sections. All the steam passes through the high-pressure section just as it does in a single back-pressure turbine. A throttle, controlled by the pressure in the process steam line, controls steam flow into the low-pressure section. If pressure drops, the throttle closes, allowing more steam to the process. If

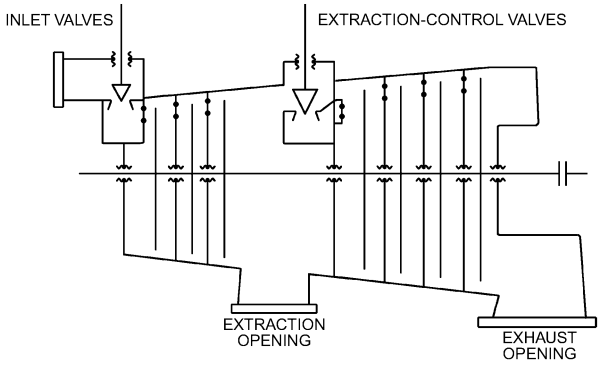


Fig. 57 Condensing Automatic Extraction Turbine

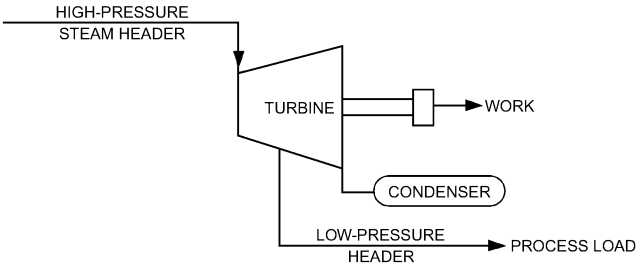


Fig. 58 Automatic Extraction Turbine CHP System

pressure rises, the throttle opens to allow steam to flow through the low-pressure section, where additional power is generated.

An automatic extraction turbine (Figure 58) is uniquely designed to meet the specific power and heat capability of a given site; therefore, no simple relationship generally applies. For preliminary design analyses, the procedures presented by Newman (1945) can be used to estimate performance. The product of such an analysis is a performance map similar to that shown in Figure 59 for a 5000 kW generator. The performance map provides steam flow to the turbine as a function of generator output with extraction flow as a parameter.

6.3 THERMALLY ACTIVATED TECHNOLOGIES

Heat-Activated Chillers

Waste heat may be converted and used to produce chilled water by several methods. The conventional method is to use hot water (>93°C) or low-pressure steam [<100 kPa (gage)] in single-stage absorption chillers. These single-stage absorbers have a COP of 0.7 or less; 1.4 kW of recovered heat can produce about 1 kW of cooling. Note that the following equations are based on full-load operation. Part-load output can be calculated by substituting the part-load COPs provided by the manufacturer for part-load COPs given here.

Hot water at 88 to 104°C, recovered from the cooling jacket loop of the prime mover, is used to produce chilled water in an indirect-fired, single-stage absorption machine. The equation to estimate the cooling produced from the heat recovered from the water is

$$q = \text{COP} \times m_w (c_p)_w (t_1 - t_2)$$

where

m_w = mass flow of water, kg/s
$(c_p)_w$ = specific heat of water, 4.18 kJ/(kg·K)
t_1 = water temperature out of engine, °C
t_2 = water temperature returned to engine, °C
[typically, $(t_1 - t_2) = 8$ K]
COP = coefficient of performance (typically 0.7)

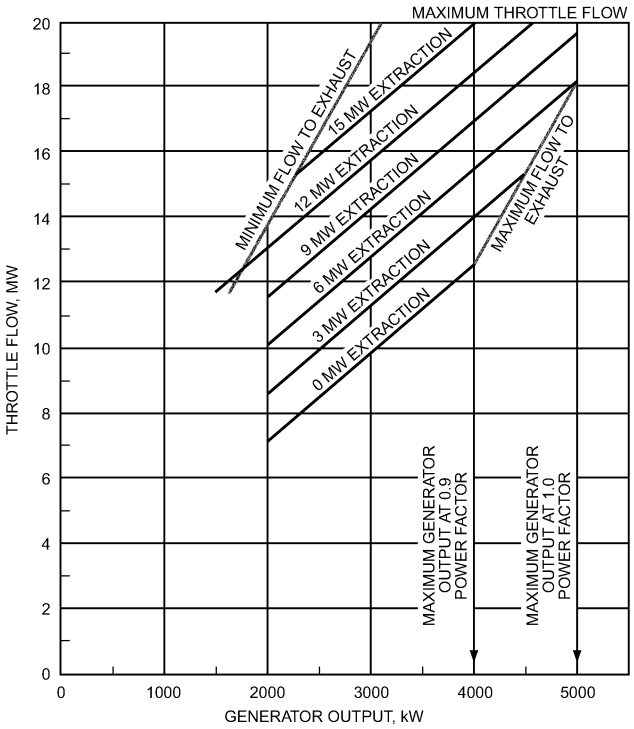


Fig. 59 Performance Map of Automatic Extraction Turbine

For engines under 2000 kW, jacket water heat and exhaust energy are usually combined to maximize cooling output from the system. In this case, jacket water passes through the engine and picks up available waste heat, and is then directed to an exhaust-to-water heat exchanger where its temperature is elevated by the exhaust energy. Flow rate is determined by the engine manufacturer and should be set to maximize the temperature differential as much as possible; the temperature differential across the engine loop is typically 8 K, and the exhaust energy can add a further 4 to 6 K, for a total differential of 14 K.

Heat may be recovered from engines and gas turbines as low- to high-pressure steam, depending on exhaust temperature. Steam pressures from 100 to 1380 kPa (gage) are common. When steam is produced at pressures over 295 kPa (gage), two-stage steam absorption chillers or steam-turbine-driven chillers can also be considered. The full-load COP at standard conditions of a steam-fired two-stage absorption chiller is typically 1.20. The steam input required is about 1.3 kg/kWh. This compares to about 2.3 kg/kWh for the single-stage absorption machine using 100 kPa (gage) steam.

Steam turbine drive chillers can accept steam pressures exceeding 1380 kPa. The turbine drive centrifugal chiller typically incorporates a variable expansion valve, which allows full-load operation at low cooling tower temperatures down to 10°C.

Providing cooling with engine exhaust heat is described in the section on Exhaust Gas Heat Recovery, and some absorption machines have been designed specifically for heat recovery in CHP applications. These units use both the jacket water and exhaust gas directly (see Figure 60).

Another type of absorption chiller uses gas engine or turbine exhaust directly (exhaust-fired absorption chiller). If a direct-exhaust, two-stage absorption chiller is used, the equation to estimate cooling produced from recoverable heat is

$$q = m_e c_p(t_1 - t_2)(1.14 \times 0.97)$$

where

q = cooling produced, kW

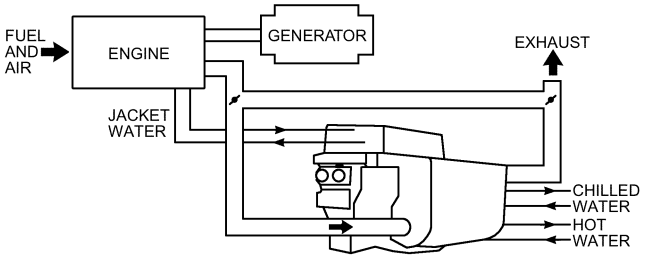


Fig. 60 Hybrid Heat Recovery Absorption Chiller-Heater

m_e = mass flow of exhaust gas, kg/s
c_p = specific heat of gas = 1.12 kJ/(kg·K)
t_1 = exhaust temperature in, °C
t_2 = exhaust temperature out = 190°C
COP = coefficient of performance (typically 1.3)
0.97 = connecting duct system efficiency

If available, the manufacturer's COP rating should be used to replace the assumed value.

Desiccant Dehumidification

Desiccant dehumidification is another essential thermally activated technology to convert low-grade waste heat into useful dehumidification, helping maximize energy savings and economic return. Both solid and liquid desiccant units have been successfully applied for many years for humidity control. Desiccants are particularly well suited to CHP because their operation requires mainly thermal energy, which can be provided from most prime movers. The energy required to remove humidity can be relatively low compared to the heat available from a prime mover, so desiccants can work in conjunction with other thermally activated technologies. Their temperature requirements are also relatively low (70 to 120°C), so they can be configured for a bottoming cycle. For more information, see Chapter 23.

Hot Water and Steam Heat Recovery

CHP heat recovery equipment encompasses all forms of heat exchangers that capture or recover waste heat or exhaust gas of a prime mover, such as a combustion turbines or natural gas or diesel engines, to generate steam or hot water. Heat recovery steam generators (HRSGs) are used to recover energy from the hot exhaust gases in power generation. Water is pumped and circulated through tubes heated by the exhaust gases and can be held under high pressure and temperature, and boiled to produce steam. HRSGs are found in may combined-cycle power plants. They were originally designed to produce steam at one pressure level; modern HRSGs may have up to three pressure levels with superheat and reheat, and may be once-through or recirculating.

A nonvolatile-fluid-based heat recovery system is one alternative to an HRSG (Meckler and Hyman 2010).

Thermal Energy Storage Technologies

Thermal energy storage (TES) can decouple power generation from the production of process heat, allowing production of dispatchable power while fully using the thermal energy available from the prime mover. Thermal energy from the prime mover exhaust can be stored as sensible or latent heat and used during peak demand periods to produce electric power or process steam/hot water. However, the additional material and equipment necessary for a TES system add to the capital costs (though there can be added value from the resulting increase in peaking capacity). As a result, evaluation of economic benefits of adding TES to a conventional CHP system must consider the increased cost of the combined system and the value of peaking capacity.

Selection of a specific storage system depends on the quality and quantity of recoverable thermal energy and on the nature of the thermal load to be supplied from the storage system. Chapter 51 has more information on thermal storage.

TES systems and technologies for power generation applications can be categorized by storage temperature. High-temperature storage can be used to store thermal energy from sources (e.g., gas turbine exhaust) at high temperatures (**heat storage**). Storage options such as oil/rock, molten nitrate salt, and combined molten salt and oil/rock are well developed and commercially available (Somasundaram et al. 1996). Medium-temperature storage with hot water can also be used.

Low-temperature TES technologies store thermal energy below ambient temperature (**cool storage**) and can be used for cooling air entering gas turbines, or for storing cooling captured from waste heat by absorption and/or steam-turbine-driven chillers. Examples include commercially available options such as diurnal ice, chilled-water, and low-temperature-fluid storage, as well as more advanced schemes represented by complex, compound chemisorption TES systems.

7. ELECTRICAL GENERATORS AND COMPONENTS

7.1 GENERATORS

Criteria for selecting alternating current (AC) generators for CHP systems are (1) machine efficiency in converting mechanical input into electrical output at various loads; (2) electrical load requirements, including frequency, power factor, voltage, and harmonic distortion; (3) phase balance capabilities; (4) equipment cost; and (5) motor-starting current requirements.

For prime movers coupled to a generator, generator speed is a direct function of the number of poles and the output frequency. For 60 Hz output, speed can range from 3600 rpm for a two-pole machine to 900 rpm for an eight-pole machine. There is a wide latitude in matching generator speed to prime mover speed without reducing the efficiency of either unit. This range in speed and resultant frequency suggests that electrical equipment with improved operation at a special frequency might be accommodated.

Induction generators are similar to induction motors in construction and control requirements. The generator draws excitation current from the utility's electrical system and produces power when driven above its synchronous speed. In the typical induction generator, full output occurs at 5% above synchronous speed.

To prevent large transient overvoltage in the induction generator circuit, special precautions are required to prevent the generator from being isolated from the electrical system while connected to power factor correction capacitors. Also, an induction generator cannot operate without excitation current from the utility; only the **synchronous generator** has its own excitation.

Prime movers that use **alternators** (to convert high-frequency AC to DC) and **inverters** (DC to AC) to produce 60/50 Hz ac power rely on the inverter design both to meet electrical specifications and for protection by the power conversion controls. The generator's rotating speed is irrelevant because the inverter creates the appropriate AC power to either follow the utility electric system voltage and frequency characteristics when operating grid-parallel, or meet the requirements of local loads when operating grid-isolated during system outages. Note that in these situations, the unit is clearly separated from the utility system by breakers or switches.

The combined efficiency of the generator, alternator, and inverter is a nonlinear function of the load and is usually maximized at or near the rated load (Figure 61).

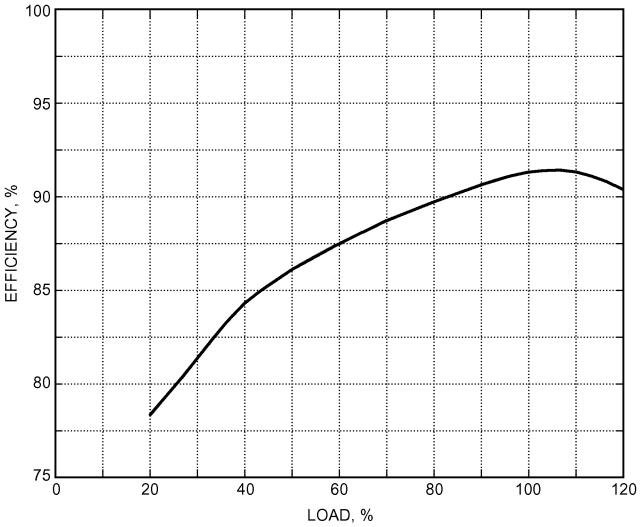


Fig. 61 Typical Generator Efficiency

The rated load estimate should include a safety factor to cover transient conditions such as short-term peaking and equipment start-up. Because combustion turbine engines can produce more power under cold ambient conditions than their ISO rating, generators are typically sized to match the engine's expected maximum power output. For combustion turbines driving alternator and inverter systems, the maximum power capability of the inverter typically limits system output. The inverter design may not support power output above the engine's ISO ratings because of the expense of the power electronics (UL 1999). Industrial generators are designed to handle a steady-state overload of 20 to 25% for several hours of continuous operation. If sustained overloads are possible, the generator ventilation system must be able to relieve the temperature rise of the windings, and the prime mover must be able to accommodate the overload.

Proper phase balance is extremely important. Driving three-phase motors and other loads from the three-phase generator presents the best phase balance, assuming that power factor requirements are met. Motor start-up can be a problem for inverter-based microturbines because they are current-limited to protect the inverter. Driving single-phase motors and building lighting or distribution systems may cause an unbalanced distribution of the single-phase loads that leads to harmonic distortion, overheating, and electrical imbalance of the generator. In practice, maximum phase imbalance can be held within 5 to 10% by proper distribution system loading.

In grid-isolated operation, voltage for synchronous generators is regulated by using static converters or rotating DC generators to excite the generator. Voltage regulation should be within 0.5% of nominal voltage and frequency regulation within 0.3 Hz from full load to no load during steady-state conditions. Good electronic three-phase voltage sensing is necessary to control the system response to load changes and excitation of paralleled alternators to ensure reactive load division.

The system power factor is reflected to the generator and should be no less than 0.8 for reasonable generator efficiency. To fall within this limit, the planned electrical load may have to be adjusted so the combined leading power factor substantially offsets the combined lagging power factor. Although more expensive, individual power factor correction at each load with properly sized capacitors is preferred to total power factor correction on the bus. On-site generators can correct some power factor problems, and for CHP systems interconnected to the grid, they improve the power factor seen by the grid.

Table 18 Generator Control Functions

Control Functions	Isolated		Parallel	
	One Engine	Two or More Engines	One Engine	Two or More Engines
Frequency	Yes	Yes	No	No
Voltage	Yes	Yes	No	No
Power	No (Load following)	Yes (Division of load)	No	Yes (Division of load)
Reactive kVAR	No (Load following)	Yes (Division of kVAR)	Yes	Yes
Heat t_1	Supplement only	Supplement only	Load following	Load following
Heat $t_2 - t_x$	Reduce from t_1 or supplement	Reduce from t_1 or supplement	Reduce from t_1 and load following	Reduce from t_1 and load following
Cooling	Remove excess heat (tower, fan, etc.)	Remove excess heat (tower, fan, etc.)	Normally no (Emergency yes)	Normally no (Emergency yes)
Synchronizing	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Black start	Yes	Yes (one engine)	Emergency use	Emergency use (one engine)

Generators operating in **parallel** with the utility system grid have different control requirements than those that operate **isolated** from the utility grid. A system that operates in parallel and provides emergency standby power if a utility system source is lost must also be able to operate in the same control mode as the system that normally operates isolated from the electric utility grid.

U.S. *National Electrical Code*® (NFPA *Standard* 70), Article 250, discusses grounding neutral connection of on-site generators. Section 250-5 covers emergency generators in electrical systems, with a four-pole transfer switch that prevents a solid neutral connection from service equipment to generator. For "separately derived systems," grounding requirements of Section 250-5(d) apply only where the generator has no direct electrical connection, including a solidly grounded circuit conductor to the normal service. The rule of grounding applies to a generator that feeds its load without any tie-in through a transfer switch to any other system, but does not apply to one with a solidly connected neutral from it to the service through a three-pole, solid neutral transfer switch.

Section 250-27(b) requires that a neutral that might function as an equipment grounding conductor have cross-sectional area of at least 12.5% of the cross-sectional area of the largest phase conductor of the generator circuit to the transfer switch.

Control requirements for systems that provide electricity and heat for equipment and electronic processors differ, depending on the number of energy sources and type of operation relative to the electric utility grid. Isolated systems generally use more than one prime mover during normal operation to allow for load following and redundancy.

Table 18 shows the control functions required for systems isolated from and in parallel with the utility grid, with single or multiple prime movers. Frequency and voltage are directly controlled in a single-engine isolated system. Power is determined by the load characteristics and is met by automatic adjustment of the throttle. Reactive power is also determined by the load and is automatically met by the exciter in conjunction with voltage control.

In parallel operation, both frequency and voltage are determined by the utility service. Power output is determined by the throttle setting, which responds to system heat requirements if thermal tracking governs, or to system power load if that governs. Only the reactive power flow is independently controlled by the generator controls.

When additional generators are added to the system, there must be a way to control the power division between multiple prime movers and for continuing to divide and control the reactive power flow. All units require synchronizing equipment.

The generator system must be protected from overload, overheating, short-circuit faults, and reverse power. The minimum protection is a properly sized circuit breaker with a shunt-trip coil for immediate automatic disconnect in the event of low voltage, overload, or reverse power. The voltage regulation control must prevent overvoltage. Circuit breakers for low voltage (below 600 V) are typically air-type, and circuit breakers for medium voltage (up to 12 000 V) should be vacuum-type. The Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers' (IEEE) *Standard* 1547 defines interconnection requirements for a paralleling local generator and the utility's electrical power system, and describes specific design, operation, and testing requirements for interconnecting generators below 10 MW and typical radial or spot network primary or secondary electrical distribution systems.

In grid-isolated operation, voltage must be held to close tolerances by the voltage regulator from no load to full load. A tolerance of 0.5% is realistic for steady-state conditions from no load to full load. The voltage regulator must allow the system to respond to load changes with minimum transient voltage variations. During parallel operation, the reactive load must be divided through the voltage regulator to maintain equal excitation of the alternators connected to the bus. True reactive load sensing is of prime importance to good reactive load division. An electronic voltage control responds rapidly and, if all three phases are sensed, better voltage regulation is obtained even if the loads are unbalanced on the phases. The construction of a well-designed voltage regulator dictates the transient voltage variation.

Engine sizing can be influenced by the control system's accuracy in dividing real load. If one engine lags another in carrying its share of the load, the capacity that it lags is never used. Therefore, if the load-sharing tolerance is small, the engines can be sized more closely to the power requirements. A load-sharing tolerance of less than 5% of unit rating is necessary to use the engine capacity to good advantage.

A load-sharing tolerance of 5% is also true for reactive load sharing and alternator sizing. If reactive load sharing is not close, a circulating current results between the alternators. The circulating current uses up alternator capacity, which is determined by the heat generated by the alternator current. The heat generated, and thus the alternator capacity, is proportional to the square of the current. Therefore, a precise control system should be installed; the added cost is justified by the possible installation of smaller engines and alternators.

8. SYSTEM DESIGN

8.1 CHP ELECTRICITY-GENERATING SYSTEMS

Good CHP planning responds to the end user's requirements and strives to maximize use of the equipment and the energy it produces. For CHP to be economically feasible, the energy recovered must match the site requirements well and avoid as much waste as possible.

Depending on the design and operating decisions, users may tie into the electric utility grid for some or all of their electric energy needs.

Thermal Loads

For maximum heat recovery, the thermal load must remove sufficient energy from the heat recovery medium to lower its temperature to that required to cool the prime mover effectively. A supplementary means for rejecting heat from the prime mover may be required if the thermal load does not provide adequate cooling during all modes of operation or, importantly, as a back-up to thermal load loss.

Internal combustion reciprocating engines have the lowest heat/power ratio, yielding most of the heat at a maximum temperature of 90 to 120°C. This jacket water heat can be used by applications requiring low-temperature heat.

Gas turbines can provide a larger quantity and a higher quality of heat per unit of power, whereas extraction steam turbines can provide even greater flexibility in both quantity and quality (temperature and pressure) of heat delivered.

If a gas turbine plant is designed to serve effectively a variety of loads (e.g., direct drying, steam generation for thermal heating or cooling, and shaft power), it is even more flexible than one that serves only one or two such loads. Of course, such diverse equipment service must be economically justified.

Prime Mover Selection

Selection of the prime mover depends on the thermal and power profiles required by the end user and on the contemporaneous relationship of these profiles. Ideally, the recoverable heat is fully used as the prime mover is fully loaded or follows the power load, but this ideal condition seldom occurs over extended periods.

For maximum equipment use and least energy waste, use the following methods to produce only the power and thermal energy that is required on site:

- Match the prime mover's heat/power ratio to that of the user's hourly load profiles.
- Store excess power as chilled water or ice when thermal demand exceeds coincident power demand.
- Store excess thermal production as heat when power demand exceeds heat demand. Either cool or heat storage must be able to productively discharge most of its energy before it is dissipated to the environment.
- Sell excess power or heat on a contract basis to a user outside of the host facility. Usually, the buyer for power is the local utility, but sometimes it is a nearby facility.

The quality of recovered energy is the second major determinant in selecting the prime mover. If the quantity of high-temperature (above 125°C) recoverable heat available from an engine's exhaust is significantly less than that demanded by end users, a combustion or steam turbine may be preferred. Figure 62 shows a typical heat recovery cycle for a gas turbine.

Low heat/power ratios of 0.6 to 1.8 kg steam/kWh output of the prime mover indicate the need for one with a high shaft efficiency of 30 to 45% (shaft energy/LHV fuel input). This efficiency is a good fit for an engine because its heat output is available as 100 kPa (gage) steam or 120°C water. Higher temperatures/pressures are available, but only from an exhaust gas recovery system, separated from the low-temperature jacket water system. However, for a typical case in which 30% of the fuel energy is in the exhaust, approximately 50% of this energy is recoverable (with 150°C final exhaust gas temperature); less than 50% is recoverable if higher steam pressures are required.

Medium heat/power ratios of 2.4 to 6.7 kg steam/kWh can be provided by combustion turbines, which are inherently low in shaft efficiency. Smaller turbines, for example, are only 27 to 34% efficient, with 66 to 73% of their fuel energy released into the exhaust. For a typical case with 70% of the fuel energy in the exhaust, assuming that approximately 55% of this energy is recoverable (with 150°C final exhaust gas temperature), net result is an overall thermal efficiency of 69% (excluding power required to drive auxiliary equipment such as fans and pumps to recover and use the exhaust heat).

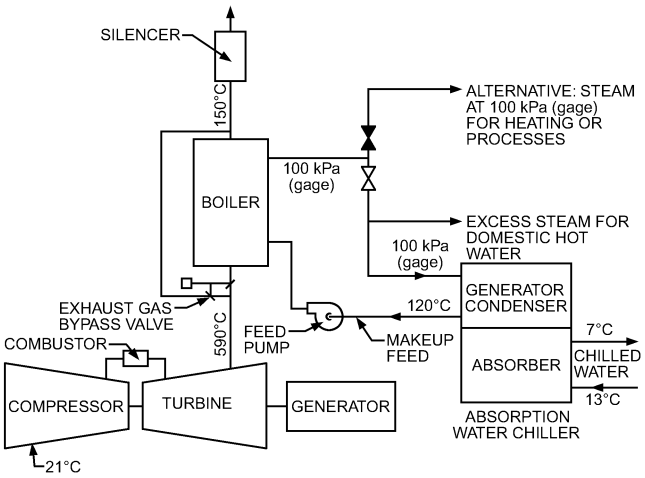


Fig. 62 Typical Heat Recovery Cycle for Gas Turbine

High heat/power ratios of 4.9 to 24.4 kg steam/kWh, provided by various steam turbine configurations, make this prime mover highly flexible for higher thermal demands. The designer can vary throttle, exhaust and/or extraction conditions, and turbine efficiency to attain the most desirable ratio for varying heat/power loads in many applications, thus furnishing a wide variety of thermal energy quality levels.

Air Systems

Large, central air handlers with deep and/or suitably circuited coils that operate with a large cooling and heating Δt (e.g., 13 K) are available to reduce distribution piping and pumping costs. These units serve multiple control zones or large single-zone spaces with air distribution ductwork. Smaller units such as perimeter fan-coil units directly condition spaces with small lengths of duct or no ductwork. Thus, they are totally decentralized from the air side of the system. The maximum Δt through the coil is often only 7 to 8 K.

Both central and decentralized air handlers can be coupled with CHP in mildly cold climates in a two-pipe changeover configuration with a small, intermediate-season electric heating coil. This arrangement can heat or cool different zones simultaneously during intermediate seasons. Chilled water is available to cool any zone. Zones needing heat can cut off the coil and turn on electric heat. A four-pipe system is unnecessary in these conditions.

When the building's balance point is reached (i.e., when all zones need heat), the pumping system is changed over to hot water. The concept applies best (and mostly) to perimeter zone layouts and to large air handlers with economizer cycles that do not need chilled water below the ambient changeover point (i.e., when economizer cooling can satisfy their loads). However, the application must have a high enough thermal demand for process or other non-space-heating loads to absorb the extra thermal energy produced by the engine generator for this additional electric heating load.

If the predominant thermal load during this period is for space heating and cooling (both at a low demand level), it makes no sense to exacerbate the already low heat/power ratio by designing for

more electrical load with no use for the heat generated. Hospitals (DOE 2007b, 2009; Kilkis 2014; Manning 1996) and apartment houses with high process heating demands are examples of suitable applications, but single-function office buildings may not be.

The significance of this CHP design is that the prime mover's electrical output can be swung from a motor-driven refrigeration load, which is less during intermediate seasons, to the electric heating function as long as the additional thermal energy can be absorbed. This can work well with engine-generators and electric cooling/refrigeration.

An absorption chiller might be a better match where the site's heat/power ratio is low, such as for an office building.

Hydronic Systems

Hydronics, particularly in buildings with no need for process or high-pressure steam, is a much more widely used transport medium than steam. See Chapter 12 for more information on hydronic system design; information on various types of terminals and systems may be found in Chapter 5. Loosely defined, hydronics covers all liquid transport systems, including (1) chilled water, heating hot water, and thermal fluids that convey energy to locations where space and process heating or cooling occur; (2) domestic or service hot water; (3) coolant for refrigeration or a process; (4) fresh or raw water for potable or process purposes; and (5) wastewater.

From a CHP design standpoint, all these applications are relevant, but some are not HVAC applications. Each application may offer an opportunity to improve the CHP system. For example, a four-pipe, two-coil system and a two-pipe, common-coil system offer similar options in plant design, with the four-pipe system offering superior flexibility for individual control of space conditions. All-electric, packaged terminal air conditioners offer little opportunity for a sizable plant, unless a substantial thermal demand (e.g., for process heat) exists in addition to normal comfort space-conditioning needs. Without the thermal demand, the only option is to install a plant that generates a fraction of the total electrical demand while satisfying service water heating requirements, for example, and to buy the bulk of the electricity required. If the site's heat/power ratio is so low that it cannot support the lowest-ratio prime mover for a large portion of the electrical demand, then a smaller plant that can operate close to a base-loaded electric generating condition might be considered.

Service Water Heating

Service hot-water systems can be a major and preferred user of thermal energy from prime movers, and often constitute a fairly level year-round load, when averaged over a 24 to 48 h period. Service hot-water use in hospitals, domiciliary facilities, etc., is usually variable in a 24 h weekday or 48 h weekend profile; thermal storage allows expanded use of the thermal output and justification for larger prime movers.

The service hot-water demand may provide a strong case for consuming the entire thermal output with packages sized for the 24 h demand, instead of for space cooling or heating.

District Heating and Cooling

The high cost of a central plant and distribution system generally mandates that significant economic returns develop soon after the central plant and distribution systems are complete. Because of the high risk, the developer must have satisfactory assurance that there are enough buyers for the product. Furthermore, the developer must know what distribution media and quality are best for connection to existing buyers and must install a system that is flexible enough for future buyers.

Generally, the load on a district system tends to level out because of the great diversity factor of the many loads and noncoincident peaking. This variety also makes plant sizing and consumption estimate aspects important.

Utility Interfacing

All electric utility interfacing requires safety on the electric grid and the ability to meet the operating problems of the electric grid and its generating system. Additional control functions depend on the desired operating method during loss of interconnection. For example, the throttle setting on a single generator operating grid-parallel with the utility is determined by either heat recovery requirements or power requirements, whichever govern, and its exciter current, which is set by the reactive power flow through the interconnection. When interconnection with the utility is lost, the generator control system must detect that loss, assume voltage and frequency control, and immediately disconnect the intertie to prevent an unsynchronized reconnection. The Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) *Standard* 1547 establishes requirements for operating the distributed generation (DG) in parallel with the grid both for normal and fault conditions. Depending on the design, the system may be able to continue operating while isolated from the grid, providing power to some or all of a facility's electrical loads as an intentional island. A key concern of this standard is to prevent **islanding** (a situation in which generator closely matches the local and/or neighboring load). Anti-islanding precautions are both for safety and protection.

With throttle control now determined solely by the electrical load, the heat produced may not match the requirements for supplemental or discharge heat from the system. When the utility source is reestablished, the system must be manually or automatically synchronized, and the control functions restored to normal operation.

Loss of the utility source may be sensed through the following factors: overfrequency, underfrequency, overcurrent, overvoltage, undervoltage, reverse power, or any combination of these. With a loss of utility source, the most severe condition occurs when the generator is delivering all electrical requirements of the system up to the point of disconnection, whether it is on the electric utility system or at the plant switchgear. Under such conditions, the generator tends to operate until the load changes, at which point, it either speeds up or slows down. This allows the over- or underfrequency device to sense loss of source and reprogram the generator controls to isolated system operation. The interconnection is normally disconnected during such a change and automatically prevented from reclosing to the electric system until the electric source is reestablished and stabilized and the generator is brought back to synchronous speed.

Power Quality

Electrical energy can be delivered to the utility grid, directly to the user, or to both, where allowed by the authority having jurisdiction (AHJ). Generators for on-site power plants can deliver electrical energy equal in quality to that provided by the electric utility in terms of voltage regulation, frequency control, harmonic content, reliability, and phase balance. They can be more capable than the utility of satisfying stringent requirements imposed by user computer applications, medical equipment, high-frequency equipment, and emergency power supplies because other end users on the utility grid can create quality problems. The generator's electrical interface should be designed according to user or utility electrical characteristics.

Output Energy Streams

Interconnects may have to be made to electrical systems of one or more voltages; to low-, medium-, or high-pressure steam systems; to chilled-water or secondary coolant systems; to low-, medium-, or high-temperature hot-water or thermal fluid systems; or to thermal energy storage systems. Each variation should be addressed in the planning stages.

Electrical. Electrical energy can produce work, heating, or cooling; it is the most transmittable form of energy. As a CHP output, it can be used to refrigerate or to supplement the prime mover's thermal output during periods of high thermal/low cooling demand. Mechanical aspects of a CHP system must be coordinated with electrical system designers who are familiar with power plant switchgear and utility and building interface requirements. See the section on Utility Interfacing for more information.

Steam. Engines and combustion and steam turbines can provide a range of pressure/temperature characteristics encountered in almost all steam systems. Their selection is basically a matter of choosing the prime mover and heat recovery steam generator combination that best suits the economic and physical goals.

Steam can also provide work, heating, or cooling, but with somewhat less range and flexibility and lower exergy than electric power. Distribution to remote users is more expensive than for electricity and is less adaptable for remote production of work.

Economics limit the pressure and/or temperature (P/T) of steam available from gas turbine exhaust because the incremental cost/benefit ratio of increasing the heat recovery generator surface to yield a higher P/T is limited by a relatively fixed exhaust gas temperature, unless the turbine is equipped with supplemental firing with an auxiliary duct burner. However, steam turbines are not similarly limited, except by throttle conditions, because extraction can be accomplished from any point in the P/T reduction process of the turbine. Chapter 11 has further information on steam systems.

Chilled Water. The entire output of any prime mover can be converted to refrigeration and then chilled water, serving the wide variety of terminal units in conventional systems. In widely spread service distribution systems, choices must be made whether to serve outlying facilities with electric, steam, or hot water. All three can be used directly, for building or process heating and/or cooling, or indirectly, through heat exchangers and mechanical or thermally activated chillers or desiccant dehumidifiers located at remote facilities.

Central chilled water production and distribution to existing individual or multibuilding complexes is most practical if a chilled water network already exists and all that is required is an interconnect at or near the CHP plant. If the buildings already have one or more types of chillers in good condition, CHP and chilled water distribution may have diminished economic prospects unless applied on a small scale to individual buildings.

If chilled-water distribution is feasible, central CHP is easier to justify, and several techniques can be used to improve the viability of a cogenerated chilled-water system by significantly reducing the owning and operating costs of piping and pumping systems and their associated components (e.g., valves, insulation, etc.). Such systems have been widely discussed, successfully developed, modified, and specified by many firms (Avery et al. 1990; Becker 1975; Hyman 2004; Mannion 1988).

Cost-reduction concepts for variable-flow water systems include the following:

- Let the main pump(s) and primary distribution system flow rate match the instantaneous sum of the demand flows from all cooling coils served by the primary loop. Chilled water should not be pumped off the primary loop in such a way as to circulate more chilled water through the secondary pump of the outlying buildings than the flow that it draws from the primary loop.
- Use two-way throttling control valves on all coils. Avoid three-way control valves for coil control or for bypassing chilled-water supply into the chilled-water return (e.g., end-of-line bypass to maintain a constant pump flow or system pressure differential). Valves must have suitable control characteristics for the system and full shutoff capability at the maximum pressure differential encountered.
- Select and circuit cooling coils for a large chilled-water temperature difference (Δt as much as 13 K) while maintaining coil tube velocities of 1.5 to 3 m/s and the required supply air conditions off the coil. Such coils may require 8 to 10 rows, but the additional pressure drop and cost are offset by the lower cost of the pump and distribution piping of long distribution systems. A system with Δt of 13 K requires only one-third the flow rate required by one with a Δt of 4 K, and the additional coil air pressure drop can be reduced or negated by using large coils with lower than standard air velocity.
- Care is necessary for successful implementation of these concepts. The *Air-Conditioning System Design Manual* (Grondzik 2007) has further design information.

Hot Water. CHP thermal output can be well adapted to low-, medium-, or high-temperature water (LTW, MTW, HTW) distribution systems. The major difference between chilled- and hot-water systems is that even LTW systems (up to 120°C) can be designed with a Δt as high as 55 K with low flow by using different series-parallel terminal circuiting, as described in Chapter 12. This way, even equipment that is limited to Δt = 10 K (e.g., radiators, convectors) can be adapted to large system temperature differences. For example, beyond those circuits given in Chapter 12, unit heaters can be piped in series and parallel on a single hot-water building loop without a conventional supply and return line. Parallel runs of five heaters each can drop in 10 K increments. The first group drops the temperature from 120 to 110°C, the last from 75 to 65°C, and all are sized at the 75 to 65°C range. Fan cycling off each local thermostat maintains control despite the different temperatures.

Similarly, larger heaters with conventional small-row coils (not metal cores) can be fitted with three-way modulating bypass valves, sized for a 5 to 20 K drop, with the through-flow and bypass flow from the first flowing to the second, and so forth, using only one primary loop.

Medium- (120 to 175°C) and high- (175°C and higher) temperature water systems are designed with an even higher Δt, but are not customarily connected directly to the primary loop. These systems can be connected to steam generators in outlying buildings that have steam distribution and steam terminal devices.

When a choice can be made, a prime mover's thermal output should be used according to the following priorities. Apply the output first for useful work, second for an efficient form of thermal conversion, and third for productive thermal use. For example, if a combustion turbine's exhaust can cost-effectively produce shaft power or, if not, heat some process, it should be considered for these functions. However, case-by-case analysis of applying heat in other thermally activated technologies is needed, because usefulness depends on specific economic conditions.

For both hot- and chilled-water distribution systems, a common approach is to lower the hot-water supply temperature as ambient temperature rises and to raise the chilled-water supply temperature as loads are reduced. Both techniques reduce pipe transmission and fuel or electrical costs for heating or cooling and stabilize valve control, but the effect of increased pumping costs is often overlooked.

Below some part-load condition in both hot- and chilled-water systems, the cost of reducing flow by varying pump speed and air volume may be more than the energy savings. This is especially true for chilled-water systems, when the cascading effect of VAV fan power reduction from lower supply air temperatures, together with pumping savings, becomes more significant than the low-load chiller savings from raising the chilled-water system temperature. Also, humidity control for the space limits how much the chilled-water temperature can rise.

These factors need to be examined in determining the part-load condition at which hot- and chilled-water system scheduling might be advantageously modified.

Table 19 Coefficient of Performance (COP) of Engine-Driven Chillers

Heat Recovery Option	COP at Full Load
No heat recovery	1.2 to 2.0
Jacket water heat recovery	1.5 to 2.25
Jacket water and exhaust heat recovery	1.7 to 2.4

8.2 CHP SHAFT-DRIVEN HVAC AND REFRIGERATION SYSTEMS

Engine-Driven Systems

HVAC Equipment. Engine-driven chillers are rated according to AHRI *Standard* 550/590 conditions. Manufacturers offer performance curves for other conditions. As with any chiller, performance is largely a function of design conditions for the condenser and chilled-water supply temperatures. The engine size required for a given chiller capacity is typically 0.2 kW per kilowatt of cooling.

Table 19 provides a typical range of engine-driven chiller coefficient of performance (COPs) with and without heat recovery. The COP is cooling energy output divided by fuel energy input. Engine fuel input is based on HHV of the fuel.

Heat recovered from the jacket coolant and exhaust gas is added to the cooling load produced by the chiller, increasing useful thermal output and the COP. Because no standards exist for calculating the COP of an engine-driven chiller when considering heat recovery, most manufacturers present COPs with and without heat recovery.

Reciprocating Compressors. Engine-driven reciprocating compressor water-chiller units may be packaged or field-assembled from commercially available equipment for comfort service, low-temperature refrigeration, and heat pump applications. Both direct-expansion and flooded chillers are used. Some models achieve low operating cost and high flexibility by combining speed variation with cylinder unloading. Part-load capacity is controlled by modulating engine speed down to about 30 to 50% of rated speed, which improves fuel economy. Some reciprocating engine chillers also use cylinder unloading to reduce capacity further. Engine speed should not be reduced below the minimum specified by the manufacturer for adequate lubrication or good fuel economy.

Most engine-driven reciprocating compressors are equipped with a cylinder loading mechanism for idle (unloaded) starting. This arrangement may be required because the starter may not have sufficient torque to crank both the engine and the loaded compressor. With some compressors, not all the cylinders (e.g., 4 out of 12) unload; in this case, a bypass valve must be installed for a fully unloaded start. The engine first reaches one-half or two-thirds of full speed. Then, a gradual cylinder load is added, and engine speed increases over a period of 2 to 3 min. In some applications, such as an engine-driven heat pump, low-speed starting may cause oil accumulation and sludge. As a result, a high-speed start is required.

These systems operate at specific fuel consumptions (SFCs) of approximately 0.3 to 0.5 m^3/kWh [0.08 to 0.14 L/(kW·s)] of pipeline-quality natural gas (HHV = 37 MJ/m^3) in sizes down to 90 kW. Comparable heat rates for diesel engines run from 10 to 13 MJ/kWh (2.8 to 3.5 W/W). Smaller units are also available. Coolant pumps can also be driven by the engine. These direct-connected pumps never circulate tower water through the engine jacket. Figure 63 shows the fuel economy effected by varying prime mover speed with reciprocating compressor load until the machine is operating at about half its capacity. Below this level, the load is reduced at essentially constant engine speed by unloading the compressor cylinders.

Frequent operation at low engine idling speed may require an auxiliary oil pump for the compressor. To reduce wear and assist in starts, a tank-type lubricant heater or a crankcase heater and a motor-driven auxiliary oil pump should be installed to lubricate the engine with warm oil when it is not running. Refrigerant piping practices for engine-driven units are the same as for motor-driven units.

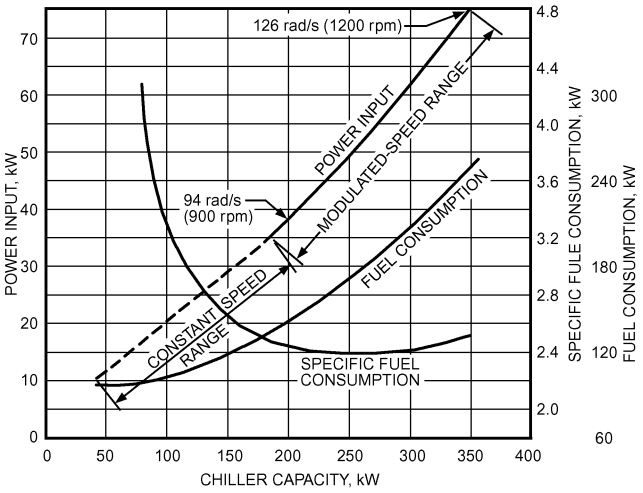


Fig. 63 Performance Curve for Typical 350 kW, Gas-Engine-Driven, Reciprocating Chiller

Table 20 Typical Efficiency of Engine-Driven Refrigeration Equipment (Ammonia Screw Compressor)

	Saturation Suction Temperature/ Saturation Discharge Temperature		
	–40/35°C	–24/35°C	–7/35°C
Electric COP	1.32	2.66	4.62
Engine-driven COP without heat recovery	0.44	0.78	1.32
Engine-driven COP with jacket water heat recovery	0.74	1.08	1.62
Engine-driven COP with jacket water and exhaust heat recovery	0.89	1.23	1.77

Source: AGCC (1999).

Centrifugal Compressors. Packaged, engine-driven centrifugal chillers that do not require field assembly are available in capacities up to 7400 kW. Automotive-derivative engines modified for use on natural gas are typical of these packages because of their compact size and mass. These units may be equipped with manual or automatic start/stop systems and engine speed controls.

Larger open-drive centrifugal chillers are usually field-assembled and include a compressor mounted on an individual base and coupled by flanged pipes to an evaporator and a condenser. The centrifugal compressor is driven through a speed increaser. Many of these compressors operate at about six times the speed of the engines; compressor speeds of up to 14 000 rpm have been used.

To affect the best compromise between the initial cost of the equipment (engine, couplings, and transmission) and maintenance cost, engine speeds between 900 and 1200 rpm are generally used. Engine output can be modulated by reducing engine speed. If operation at 100% of rated speed produces 100% of rated output, approximately 60% of rated output is available at 75% of rated speed. Capacity control of the centrifugal compressor can be achieved by variable inlet guide vane control with constant compressor speed, or a combination of variable-speed control and inlet guide vane control, the latter providing the greatest operating economy.

Heat Pumps. An additional economic gain can result from operating an engine-driven refrigeration cycle as a heat pump, if the facility has a thermal load profile that can adequately absorb its 40 to 50°C low-quality heat. Using the same equipment for both heating and cooling reduces capital investment. A gas engine drive for heat pump operation also makes it possible to operate in a CHP

mode, which requires a somewhat larger thermal load. Unless a major portion of this larger thermal recovery can be absorbed, the cycle may not be economical.

The classic definition of reverse-cycle performance is (heat out)/(work in). The definition does not recognize the fuel input to the engine, just as it ignores the fuel input to generate the electricity for the motor of a motor-driven compressor. No coefficient of performance is really defined for the cycle that captures jacket and exhaust heat.

Screw Compressors. Chiller packages with these compressors are available for refrigeration applications. Manufacturers offer water chillers that use screw compressors driven directly by natural gas engines. Capacity control is achieved by varying engine speed and adjusting the slide valve on the compressor. Chapter 38 has more information on compressors.

Because refrigeration equipment operates at low evaporator temperatures (–5 to –60°C), refrigerants such as ammonia and other cycles that improve efficiency over single-stage cycles are used. Besides the standard, single-stage vapor compression cycle, a multistage or cascade refrigeration cycle may be chosen. The multistage cycle is the most common cycle used to efficiently provide refrigeration from –18 to –60°C. The section on Compression Refrigeration Cycles in Chapter 2 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describes this cycle.

As with engine-driven chillers, heat recovery from the jacket coolant and exhaust gas boosts overall energy use and efficiency. Table 20 lists the coefficient of performance and effect of heat recovery for a range of conditions.

Combustion-Turbine-Driven Systems

The gas turbine has become increasingly important as a prime mover for electric power generation up to more than 240 MW and for shaft power drives up to more than 145 MW. Figure 64 shows a typical gas turbine refrigeration cycle, with optional combustion air precooling. A gas turbine must be brought up to speed by an auxiliary starter. With a single-shaft turbine, the air compressor, turbine, speed reducer gear, and refrigeration compressor must all be started and accelerated by this starter. The refrigeration compressor must also be unloaded to ease the starting requirement. Sometimes, this may be done by making sure the capacity control vanes close tightly. At other times, it may be necessary to depressurize the refrigeration system to get started.

With a split-shaft design, only the air compressor and the gas producer turbine must be started and accelerated. The rest of the unit starts rotating when enough energy has been supplied to the blades of the power turbine. At this time, the gas producer turbine is up to speed, and the fuel supply is ignited. Electric starters are usually available as standard equipment. Reciprocating engines, steam turbines, and hydraulic or pneumatic motors may also be used. The output shaft of the gas turbine must rotate in the direction required by the refrigeration compressor; in many cases, manufacturers of split-shaft engines can provide the power turbine with either direction of rotation.

At low loads, both the gas turbine unit and centrifugal refrigeration machine are affected by surge, a characteristic of all centrifugal and axial flow compressors. At a certain pressure ratio, a minimum flow through the compressor is necessary to maintain stable operation. In the unstable area, a momentary backward flow of gas occurs through the compressor. Stable operation can be maintained, however, by using a hot-gas bypass valve.

The turbine manufacturer normally includes automatic surge protection, either as a bleed valve that bypasses some of the air directly from the axial compressor into the exhaust duct or by providing for a change in the position of the axial compressor stator vanes. Both methods are used in some cases.

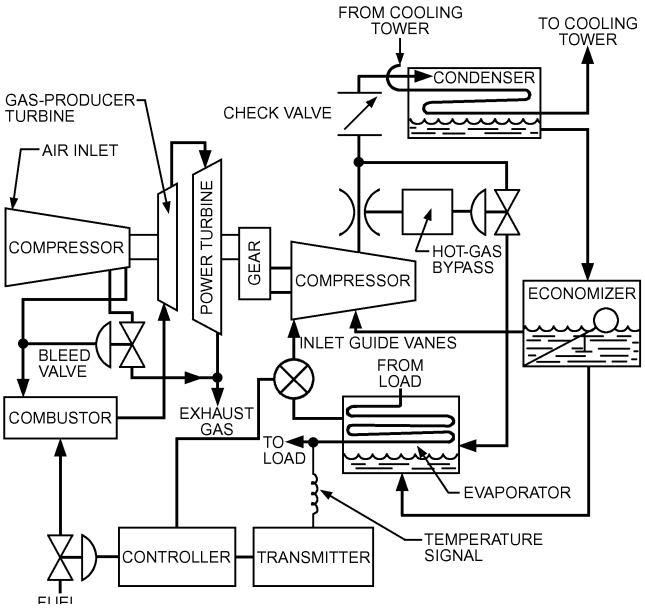


Fig. 64 Typical Gas Turbine Refrigeration Cycle

The assembly should be prevented from rotating backward, which may occur if the unit is suddenly stopped by one of the safety controls. The difference in pressure between the refrigeration condenser and cooler can make the compressor suddenly become a turbine and cause it to rotate in the opposite direction. This rotation can force hot turbine gases back through the air compressor, causing considerable damage. Reverse flow through the refrigeration compressor may be prevented in a variety of ways, depending on the system's components.

When there is no refrigerant receiver, quick-closing inlet guide vanes are usually satisfactory because there is very little high-pressure refrigerant to cause reverse rotation. However, when there is a receiver, a substantial amount of energy is available to cause reverse rotation. This can be reduced by opening the hot-gas bypass valve on shutdown and installing a discharge check valve on the compressor.

The following safety controls are usually supplied with a gas turbine:

- Overspeed
- Compressor surge
- Overtemperature during operation under load
- Low oil pressure
- Failure to light off during start cycle
- Underspeed during operation under load

A fuel supply regulator can maintain a single-shaft gas turbine at a constant speed. With the split-shaft design, the turbine's output shaft runs at the speed required by the refrigeration compressor. The temperature of chilled water or brine leaving the cooler of the refrigeration machine controls the fuel. See also the section on Fuels and Fuel Systems.

Steam-Turbine-Driven Systems

Steam turbines in air conditioning and refrigeration are mainly used to drive centrifugal compressors, which are usually part of a chilled-water or secondary-coolant chilling system using one of the newer or halogenated hydrocarbon refrigerants. In addition, many industrial processes use turbine-driven centrifugal compressors with various other refrigerants such as ammonia, propane, butane, or other process gases.

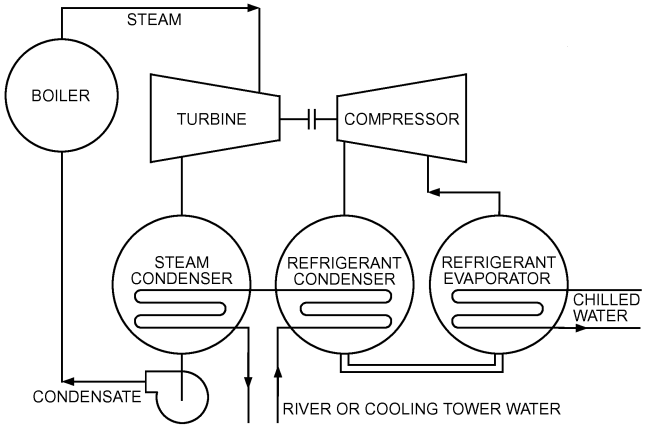


Fig. 65 Condensing Turbine-Driven Centrifugal Compressor

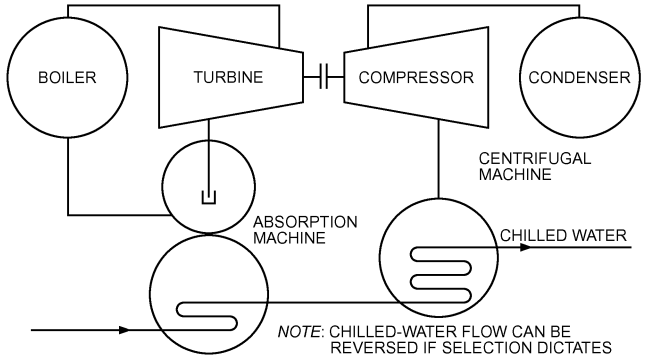


Fig. 66 Combination Centrifugal-Absorption System

Related applications of steam turbines include driving chilled-water and condenser-water circulating pumps and serving as prime movers for electrical generators in CHP systems. In industrial applications, the steam turbine may be advantageous, serving either as a work-producing steam pressure reducer or as a scavenger using otherwise wasted low-pressure steam.

Many steam turbines are used in urban areas where commercial buildings are served with steam from a central public utility or municipal source. Institutions where large central plants serve a multitude of buildings with heating and cooling also use steam-turbine-driven equipment.

Most steam turbines driving centrifugal compressors for air conditioning are multistage condensing turbines (Figure 65), which provide good steam economy at reasonable initial cost. Usually, steam is available at 350 kPa (gage) or higher, and there is no demand for exhaust steam. However, turbines may work equally well where an abundance of low-pressure steam is available. As an example of the wide range of application of this turbine, one industrial firm drives a sizable capacity of water-chilling centrifugal compressors with an initial steam pressure of less than 28 kPa (gage), thus balancing summer cooling against winter heating with steam from generator-turbine exhausts.

Aside from wide industrial use, the noncondensing (back-pressure) turbine is most often used in water-chilling plants to drive a centrifugal compressor that shares the cooling load with one or more absorption units (Figure 66). Exhaust steam from the turbine, commonly at about 100 kPa (gage), serves as the heat source for the absorption unit's generator (concentrator). This dual use of heat energy in the steam generally results in a lower energy input per unit of refrigeration output than is attained by either machine operating alone. An important aspect in design of combined systems is balancing turbine exhaust steam flow with absorption input steam requirements over the full range of load.

Extraction and mixed-pressure turbines are used mainly in industry or in large central plants. Extracted steam is often used for boiler feedwater heating or other processes where steam with lower heat content is needed. Most motor-driven centrifugal refrigeration compressors are driven at constant speed (some with variable-frequency drives). However, governors on steam turbines can maintain a constant or variable speed without the need for expensive variable-frequency drives.

9. CODES AND INSTALLATION

9.1 GENERAL INSTALLATION PARAMETERS

Structural support for the equipment must be adequate for the operating weight and any inertial forces.

Depending on the fuel(s) chosen for the system, it may be important to address location and capacity of **fuel supply** and storage.

Ventilation is required to supply adequate combustion air and prevent plant overheating.

Exhaust systems must be constructed of materials resistant to corrosion by exhaust gases, and condensate drains are usually required. Locate exhaust outlets carefully to avoid noise and pollution problems.

Monitoring systems should allow operators to monitor CHP performance for maintenance and economic purposes. As a minimum, the following should be monitored:

- CHP run time
- Fuel consumption
- Electrical power generated in each period (minus parasitic losses)
- Usable heat produced
- Duration and cause of any plant failure
- Cost of fuels, maintenance, etc.

Acoustic attenuation is often necessary for CHP units. Packaged plants usually come in a purpose-built acoustic enclosure. In addition, silencers must be fitted to the exhaust system. Antivibration mountings and couplings are usually standard.

Commissioning and **testing** are key. The plant must be tested under various loads, according to the manufacturer's instructions. Pumps, electrical switchgear, and controls need careful commissioning to ensure they operate as designed. Test that electrical output can be synchronized, paralleled, and disconnected safely. Where installed, heat rejection systems should be tested across a range of loads to establish that sufficient heat can be rejected and overheating avoided. Also, ensure that the CHP unit interacts correctly with the existing heating system.

At project completion, proof of commissioning and operating instruction documentation must be provided. In particular, the CHP system must be included in the building log book required by building regulations. Permits and approvals also should be handed over, and appropriate staff trained to monitor the plant. Most of this is usually done by the CHP supplier, but is ultimately the client's responsibility.

It is important to monitor the immediate and ongoing system performance. As soon as operation begins, detailed monitoring is essential to confirm efficiency and economic viability. Continuous monitoring is required to maintain long-term performance, particularly as fuel costs and electricity prices change.

9.2 UTILITY INTERCONNECTION

Requirements for interconnection with public utilities' grids vary by cogenerator and by the individual electric utility, depending on generation equipment, size, and host utility systems. Interconnection equipment requirements increase with generator size and

voltage level. Generally, complexity of the utility interface depends on the mode of transition between paralleling and stand-alone operation. The plant connection to the electric grid must have an automatic utility tie-breaker and associated protective relays. When utility power is lost, this tie-breaker opens and isolates the generator and its loads from the utility. Protective relays at the entrance and generator must be coordinated so that the utility tie-breaker opens before the generator's breaker. An automatic load control system is needed to shed noncritical loads to match generator's capacity. When utility power returns, the generator must be synchronized with the utility across the utility tie-breaker, whereas under normal start-up conditions the generator is synchronized across the generator circuit breaker. The synchronizing equipment must accommodate both situations.

When a CHP system is integrated into the utility system, the following issues must be understood and managed:

- Control and monitoring
- Metering
- Protection
- Stability
- Voltage, frequency, synchronization, and reactive compensation for power factors
- Safety
- Power system imbalance
- Voltage flicker
- Harmonics
- Grounding

Many jurisdictions have developed standard interconnections requirements, most of which are based on IEEE *Standard* 1547 and UL *Standard* 1741. IEEE *Standard* 1547 addresses performance, operation, testing, and safety of interconnection products and services, such as hardware and software for distributed power control and communication. It also discusses product quality, interoperability, design, engineering, installation, and certification, and provides a platform for standardized interconnection throughout the United States.

9.3 AIR PERMITS

Basic air permitting and emission control requirements are as follows:

- De minimis exemptions
- State minor source permitting
- Major source permitting
- Emergency generators

Most states have a **de minimis exemption**, a threshold below which units are either small enough or have emissions low enough that they do not have to apply for a permit of any kind. Requirements and conditions vary by state. Even when the CHP system does not require a construction permit, it may be advisable to file an information copy with the permitting authority.

Sources that are not exempted must obtain a permit to construct and to operate. An important factor in determining how a source is permitted is its **potential to emit**, which is the measure of its maximum possible emissions if operated at full capacity for 8760 h per year. If a source's potential emissions exceed certain thresholds, it is considered a major source and, in the United States, is subject to federal new source review permitting. The trigger threshold depends on local air quality.

Intermediate-level sources are generally subject to state minor source permitting.

Both minor and major source permits are likely to require some kind of emission limitations or controls, which could be anything from raising a unit's stack height to installing the most stringent control technologies available. The permitting process also can range from a simple application to a complex cost-based technology evaluation. Requirements vary by state and the type of unit proposed.

In addition, most states have special treatment for emergency back-up generators. The EPA recommends calculating emergency units' the potential to emit based on 500 h of operation per year.

Note that air permits are required before any construction can begin.

9.4 BUILDING, ZONING, AND FIRE CODES

U.S. building design and construction codes (except for federal buildings and facilities) are typically developed at the state and local level. Because power generation in the United States has typically been regulated from within the utility industry, few provisions exist in standards, codes, and building construction regulations for CHP systems; in fact, many codes explicitly exempt facilities used exclusively for generating electricity. As a result, there is very little regulatory guidance for power generation technologies and installations, and most code officials are not experienced in design, construction, installation, or operation of power plants, and particularly generators serving commercial buildings.

Important considerations include the following.

Zoning

Zoning regulations are locally implemented and enforced, but typically are based on national standards. Topics addressed range from noise regulations to visual impact. Blanket prohibitions on electricity generation, limits on operation of back-up generators, and height restrictions on towers for wind generators, are not uncommon. In these cases, the developer must obtain an exception, which increases the expense and time needed for approval.

Building Code/Structural Design

The site must structurally support the system load and vibration. If a unit is installed within a building, the whole building may need to be reclassified for occupancy. The unit cannot block egress from the building.

Mechanical/Plumbing Code

Some localities do not allow installation of gas-fired units not listed as gas appliances by an approved agency. In these cases, a registered engineer must certify that the installation meets all applicable standards and is in safe operating condition, and must seek an exemption. Codes also regulate use of gas meters, piping and emergency shutoff valves.

Fire Code

Fire prevention and firefighters' access to equipment during an emergency are strongly regulated by code rules. The type of fuel (natural gas, oil, propane, etc.) used must be determined, and its flammability and combustibility analyzed. The fire department must know a unit's location and how to disconnect it in case of a fire. A fire suppression system may be necessary for buildings with interior CHP systems.

Applicable codes and standards of the National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) include the following:

- *Standard* 850, Electric Generating Plants
- *Standard* 37, Installation and Use of Stationary Combustion Engines and Gas Turbines, which also covers temporary, portable supplementary engines
- *Standard* 54, National Fuel Gas Code
- *Standard* 70, National Electrical Code®

Electrical Connection

The most important electrical decision is the point of connection. Connection on the line side creates the fewest design problems.

When connecting on the load side, the service equipment's ampacity, ground fault protection, and system neutral bonding must be considered.

10. ECONOMIC EVALUATION

The purpose of a CHP economic evaluation is to provide sufficient data to allow stakeholders to understand whether the potential financial gain through cost savings is adequate to justify the investment required. The economic analysis is generally the most important piece of reporting in the CHP evaluation process, but it depends on having accurate data relating to key factors (e.g., loads, utility tariffs, system performance, installation costs).

The **load assessment** generally is the starting point for sizing and configuring the CHP system, whether the emphasis is on economics only or on providing standby power, emissions reductions, etc. The load assessment should include as thorough a definition as possible of energy use and demand data, as well as the load characteristics and the facility's physical attributes, including thermal connection points, power interconnection, power distribution grid layout, space availability, and existing equipment. An important aspect is determining whether the available loads are addressable by the CHP system. To this end, each facility load should be profiled by type and quality of energy required to satisfy facility needs. Furthermore, loads must be properly profiled to obtain a detailed understanding of load variations on a seasonal, monthly, weekly, daily, and hourly basis.

CHP plants are typically sized to meet base loads and generally have a constant electric and thermal output, with some limited variation possible. CHP systems that include duct burners or that are designed to provide variable electric output can provide more varied thermal output, but will still have a base load thermal output that should be used to the fullest extent possible. On the other hand, facility loads can have wide variations throughout the day, as well as significant changes from season to season or from work day to weekend day. A facility must have some level of load consistency as well as concurrency in thermal and electric loads for it to be appropriate for CHP application, although energy storage or demand management may be used to better shape the available thermal and electric load profile. An accurate profile of each addressable load must still be developed to understand the functioning and interaction of the facility and the CHP plant. Although actual hourly, daily, or weekly load data may not be available, some estimation of how the loads vary is necessary.

CHP Application Assessment

A CHP application assessment is a multistep process. Each successive step provides a higher level of detail, guiding the decision to move to the next step in a stage-gate type process. This approach not only develops the needed level of information, but also controls cost during decision making. In some situations, the first steps may be skipped if sufficient knowledge of site loads and CHP technology exists. The ultimate goal is to provide an investment-grade engineering study that delivers sufficient detail to all decision-making parties involved with the project's progression. The results are engineering based and should provide statements of pre- and post-CHP facility energy use and energy cost, effects of existing systems operation and utility rates, and a capital and operating cost estimate for the project (including maintenance).

Several issues should be addressed early in the process to identify anything that could prevent further action or enhance the CHP plant's value. Matters such as environmental considerations, power availability and quality, standby power requirements, plans for future expansion or contraction, pending equipment replacement, and financial standing can significantly influence feasibility, performance, design, and benefit. Senior decision makers should also be involved early, where possible, so that all issues can be understood and the goals of the project clearly identified. Economic and technical measures of CHP system performance that are useful and meaningful within the end user's decision-making framework must be developed.

Technical feasibility is based on multiple factors, including

- Existence of adequate concurrent electric and thermal loads, and availability of natural gas or other acceptable fuels
- Compatibility of existing processes or mechanical systems with recoverable heat available from a prime mover
- Availability of space for siting the CHP system, and ability to interconnect with facility thermal and electrical systems
- Adequacy of existing systems, including load management, standby/peak boilers and chillers, electric grid, switchgear, etc.

Economic feasibility is critical to most projects and can be included to the technical study and load analysis to determine the costs of operating with or without CHP. There are two main approaches. With **payback**, the cost saving with CHP needs to overcome the net capital costs associated with the project within a time period acceptable to the owner. This test provides an easily understood metric, but does not fully describe the project economics. The second test, **return on investment** over a specified period, typically incorporates allowances for inflation, taxes, and the cost of money and is a truer description of the project from an economic perspective; however, this is a more complex assessment. Although the earliest efforts should uncover any potential roadblocks or fatal flaws, the facility's size and complexity as well as the desired level of detail determine what level of investigation is required. If grant application forms require submitting engineering documents or studies, then the technical data supply scope of the grant requirement should be included as a study requirement.

Types and Scope of CHP Studies

There are three general categories of CHP studies, varying from a basic screening study to the investment-grade audit used to make investment decisions (ASHRAE 2011). **Level 1 screening studies** are typically based on site energy use data and do not include a comprehensive review of the facility. These are often provided free of charge by equipment vendors, CHP developers, or support agencies and should be viewed as a go/no-go decision point for the next phase of engineering review. The **Level 2 feasibility analysis** provides a more thorough review of energy use data as well as some level of site suitability for the application of CHP, including a general assessment of load addressability. If the Level 2 study suggests that CHP is appropriate for the application, then the next phase of study is a **Level 3 assessment** (also called **investment-grade audit**), which requires a higher level of engineering expertise and effort and is designed to provide a detailed analysis of how a proposed CHP configuration would perform. Level 2 and 3 CHP analyses are generally provided by consulting engineering companies (nonaligned with any equipment vendor or project developer) with experience in the application of CHP as well as energy systems operation and will also typically require some funds to be allocated to the project.

U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) Analysis. The EPA developed a slightly different approach (EPA 2015) that focuses on a single project. This process has two levels: a **Level 1 analysis** to determine whether CHP is a technical fit for the facility and might offer economic benefits; and a **Level 2 CHP feasibility analysis**, which is a detailed examination of the economic and technical viability of installing a CHP system. A Level 2 study may consider the return on investment for multiple CHP system sizes, configurations, and thermal technology options. The Level 2 study normally follows a Level 1 CHP feasibility analysis and is based on more detailed engineering and operational data from the site. In essence, the EPA's Level 2 approach combines the ASHRAE Levels

2 and 3 using a single technical approach (e.g., economic on-site generation, renewables, facility resiliency).

Selecting an Approach. In all cases, the underlying assumptions and valuation made when developing the load factor and worth of utility offsets and/or capital cost offsets should be transparent and should be checked for validity. The analysis of CHP should be based on a comparison between a CHP system and the conventional system that best meets the requirements of the site and the owner without CHP. Thus, if an absorption chiller is not the optimum choice for a site, it should not be considered as part of the conventional system even if it is included in the proposed CHP configuration. In this case, the conventional system budget and operating costs should be based on the operation of an electric chiller, assuming it is the conventional choice for such an application or existing equipment. CHP energy cost savings would then be based on the purchased power and maintenance costs of the electric-chiller-based conventional system versus the absorption-based CHP system. Similar concerns exist with regard to standby engines, conservation, load management, and the overall design of the site's processes and HVAC systems. Evaluation of CHP or other nonconventional options must be conducted within the context of existing equipment or the alternative conventional system for the site. Moreover, if that existing system does not currently operate at reasonable efficiency, it is necessary to determine whether it can be cost-effectively restored to efficient operation. As an example, CHP may be economical by comparison to an inefficient boiler plant (e.g., an old and oversized unit operating at an overall efficiency of 55%). In this situation, the recovered heat would be divided by 0.55 to determine the amount of fuel displaced and it would be highly valued. However, it may be more cost effective to improve the efficiency of the existing boiler and increase its efficiency to 75%. In this case, the value of recovered heat would be decreased by approximately 36% and the CHP system may no longer be viable.

Selecting the optimum CHP system should be based on the criteria developed with the project end-user or owner, whether those criteria consider economics, risk, emissions impact, energy efficiency, reliability, or some other performance measures. An important decision that should be made early in the process is project ownership. This can affect several key factors, including capital cost, term of project, operating cost, and tax treatment. Ownership is based on a number of issues, including risk/reward acceptance and the availability of cash or alternative funding. If the end user seeks third-party ownership and operation, it may be prudent to limit the detailed design activities to those necessary to select a third-party concept and to negotiate a third-party contract. The third party will most likely want to conduct its own investment-grade audit.

In general, the output of the ASHRAE or EPA Level 1 study should include a projected capital budget, CHP-related energy cost savings, projected operating costs for the CHP plant, and utility cost sensitivity. As a result, the owner or developer should be able to make a decision as to the general technical approach and how the project is to be developed.

The output of the ASHRAE Level 3 or EPA Level 2 study should include capital cost estimates and decisions about the manufacturer of prime mover, total installed capacity, number of prime movers, anticipated operating mode, approach to permitting, project schedule, strategy for supplemental and standby power, approach to fuel supply and purchasing, utility cost sensitivity, and approach to maintenance and staffing. This level of study should also identify the source of data used and any data collection activities that are required for detailed design, including recommendations for collection of profile data and measurement of selected power and thermal loads.

When third-party financing or loans are used, an additional layer of financial modeling is required. This financial model is normally site specific and incorporates confidential decisions on the **internal rate of return (IRR)**, tax implications, financing methods, discount rate, amortization schedule, end of life value and ownership structure. The ASHRAE Level 3 or EPA Level 2 study results should provide capital cost and operating data in a form that can be used by others in the development of the financial model.

Many grant programs, where available, have a well-documented list of informational requirements for some level of performance and economic analysis, as well as a technical description of the proposed CHP configuration including operating strategy, annualized useful output and annualized efficiency. Much of the information required for grant applications can typically be derived from the information reported through the investment-grade audit. If considering a financial support mechanism, then the analysis should report the technical information in the format required by the program application.

CHP System Modeling Techniques

Load-duration- or typical-day-based analyses can be acceptable analytical techniques for simpler and smaller CHP systems or during the initial stages of design development of larger systems. They may even be acceptable for system performance modeling of larger wholesale power projects that are operated independent of site-specific thermal and/or electrical requirements. However, they are generally inadequate for nonexport CHP systems serving multiple and independently varying facility loads, particularly if these loads and the CHP system performance are functions of ambient weather conditions.

Hour-by-hour modeling of the facility's HVAC, energy, and power requirements for an entire year is generally preferred for larger, more complex systems serving buildings. This is particularly important if the CHP system capacity is higher than the base load and it is designed to track either a thermal or electrical load or both, and where those loads vary as a function of both occupancy and weather. Because building heating, cooling, power, and process loads vary continuously over a broad range of values, a nonexport CHP system with a capacity higher than the base loads will also be required to vary continuously over a broad range, significantly complicating the analysis of part-load operation. Because power requirements and therefore heat rate and heat recovery are functions of both building loads and ambient temperatures, hour-by-hour modeling may be necessary for the performance analysis of any tracking system. Other considerations that may require the use of an hour-by-hour model are where

- Cogenerated power is both used internally to displace power purchases and sold to the wholesale market; particularly if the value of power used internally is significantly different from that of wholesale power, it is necessary to quantify power exports on an hourly basis
- Utility rates for supplemental and standby service require more detailed modeling of the hourly output of the CHP system, either as a basis for determining the total cost of power or, if standby rates are significant, for determining the cost for the use of standby power
- CHP system performance depends on ambient weather conditions (e.g., with combustion turbines), cooling towers are required for heat rejection, or absorption or evaporative chillers are used to precool turbine inlet air
- Demand-side management or load-shifting techniques such as thermal storage are used or being considered

Industrial facilities or some institutional facilities, such as hospitals, with significant process type loads, typically exhibit less variation in day-to-day requirements and their energy requirements are less sensitive to hourly weather changes. Moreover, these systems generally operate at a limited number of discrete output levels, and model part-load performance is considerably simpler than

is the case for CHP systems that must serve continuously varying loads. Hour-by-hour analyses based on a limited number of typical days that are defined by production levels, season, or some other parameter are a primary determinant of energy requirements. The use of an hour-by-hour analysis on a typical-day basis can significantly reduce computational requirements as compared to the 8760 h of analysis required for an entire year.

Thermal profile data for sites that use oil, coal, or other bulk delivery fuels may be difficult to develop. In general, these fuels are typically limited to boiler use and can be entirely displaced with recovered heat. However, fuel deliveries are on an as-needed basis and may not be analytically linked to thermal profiles. In these cases, it may be necessary to rely on discussions with facility operations personnel together with any available energy production data such as steam charts or condensate return readings as an alternative to steam production. Where thermal use profiles are highly variable and no historical data exists, it may be necessary to install metering and logging equipment to obtain a reference point for current conditions.

CHP Feasibility Study for New Facilities

The analysis of CHP at new buildings may present particular problems as there are no existing baseline energy data; moreover, the specific mechanical systems may not have been finalized, resulting in even less certainty. One source of useful information is other similar facilities for which data are available. Where energy models have already been developed for the facility, the output of such models can be used as the basis for CHP system performance.

Tools and Software for Feasibility Study

There are several publicly available free tools, as well as privately developed tools available at a cost, that can be used to help assess a CHP application. Generally, the level of output accuracy is commensurate with input detail. Simpler tools that provide the user with few input options and require only annual data should be considered as screening tools to provide a go/no-go answer to the requirement for further study. These types of tools typically do not address the difference between fuel use and addressability of thermal loads, and are designed to provide some concept of theoretical potential for CHP at the site. The advantage of such tools is that they require little time to produce results and are generally available free of charge.

More sophisticated tools that provide greater detail and more accurate results can require significant time to input data appropriately. Many of these programs contain databases of equipment performance and cost characteristics that are very useful in running various CHP configurations, but these databases can become dated unless they are continually updated. Many also contain template energy load profiles for typical applications and allow the user to adjust these profiles to match specific site conditions. Generally, these more sophisticated programs include localized weather data that adjust load profiles based on location and, combined with the application templates, can provide a high degree of accuracy in determining total facility loads. Although these programs are very useful and essentially combine building modeling and CHP performance, they generally cannot account for physical constraints, addressability of loads, or other overarching issues that can only be revealed with a proper engineering site visit. However, they can be particularly useful for new buildings where load information is not available.

ASHRAE's (2015) *Combined Heat and Power Design Guide* comes with a CHP analysis tool: a spreadsheet (I-P units only) that provides reliable and transparent cost savings resulting from the application of CHP with a minimum of user effort. The new tool assumes the user to have some technical understanding of a prime mover's energy balance, and provides an understanding of the host site thermal systems. It relies on the user to make some quantitative decisions to overcome complex issues, thereby greatly enhancing the tool's ability to provide accurate results with the minimum of input. The tool can profile an existing or new facility in terms of monthly electric and thermal energy use.

The new tool takes a novel approach to solving the issue of obsolescence of equipment databases by allowing the user to input the parameters for the CHP system characteristics independently of the technology selection. This recognizes the practical fact that, no matter what technology is used, all outputs can be expressed as a percentage of the fuel input. However, this approach requires the user to calculate the appropriate electric and thermal efficiencies based on fuel input, which can easily be determined from manufacturer data.

Although CHP performance and energy costs are the most important factors to consider from a theoretical perspective, the real issue when trying to calculate the economic performance of a CHP plant is accurately assessing the addressable thermal loads. This has been the most common failure in CHP application design, and one that ASHRAE (2015) and its associated spreadsheet seek to resolve. The CHP analysis tool requires input to a series of questions on thermal loads and existing equipment to determine the possible applications for waste heat from a chosen CHP configuration. This requires some level of site investigation and knowledge of energy equipment by the user, which the authors believe is necessary to provide a reasonably accurate result.

The new model provides an operation and maintenance cost evaluation together with energy cost offsets from the CHP plant that result in monthly savings and costs, and returns a current-dollar annual savings statement for the proposed system together with the annualized system efficiency. Based on the technology and size chosen, suggested inputs for capital cost will be provided that can be used or altered by the user. Non-CHP costs, incentives that might apply as well as other monthly costs and/or savings can be input by the user to develop a simple payback statement. The average energy cost is determined by the tool, and a sensitivity analysis for higher and lower electric and gas prices is determined and provided, including simple payback for each scenario.

10.1 LOAD PROFILES AND LOAD DURATION CURVES

Load Duration Curve Analysis

A much more comprehensive energy analysis, combined with an economic analysis, must be used to select a CHP system that maximizes efficiency and economic return on investment. For better identification and screening of potential candidates, a simplified but accurate performance analysis must be conducted that considers the dynamics of the facility's electrical and thermal loads, as well as the size and fuel consumption of the prime mover.

Accurate analysis is especially important for commercial and institutional CHP applications because of the large time-dependent changes in magnitude of load and the often noncoincident nature of the power and thermal loads. A facility containing a generator sized and operated to meet the thermal demand may occasionally have to purchase supplemental power and sometimes may produce power in excess of facility demand.

Even in the early planning stages, a reasonably accurate estimate of the following must be determined:

- Fuel consumed (if it is a topping cycle)
- Amount of supplemental electricity that must be purchased
- Amount of supplemental boiler fuel (if any) that must be purchased
- Amount of excess power available for sale
- Electrical capacity required from the utility for supplemental and standby power.
- Electrical capacity represented by any excess power if the utility offers capacity credits

Obtaining estimates of these performance values for multiple time-varying loads is difficult, and is further complicated by utility rate structures that may be based on time-of-day or time-of-year purchase and sale of power. Data must be collected at intervals short enough to give the desired levels of accuracy, yet taken over a long period and/or a well-selected group of sampling periods.

A basic method for analyzing HVAC system performance is the bin method. The basic tool for sizing and evaluating power system performance is the load duration curve, which contains the same information as bins, but arranges the load data in a slightly different manner. The load duration curve is a plot of hourly averaged instantaneous load data over a period; the plot is rearranged to indicate the frequency, or hours per period, that the load is at or below the stated value. The load duration curve is constructed by sorting the hourly averaged load values of the facility into descending order. Large volumes of load data can be easily sorted with spreadsheets or databases. The load duration curve produces a visually intuitive tool for sizing CHP systems and for accurately estimating system performance.

Figure 67 shows a hypothetical steam load profile for a plant operating with two shifts each weekday and one shift each weekend day; no steam is consumed during nonworking hours for this example. The data provide little information for thermally sizing a generator, except to indicate that the peak demand for steam is about 14 MW and the minimum demand is about 4 MW.

Figure 68 is a load duration curve (a descending-order sort) of the steam load data in Figure 67. Mathematically, the load duration curve shows the frequency with which load equals or exceeds a given value; the curve is one minus the integral of the frequency distribution function for a random variable. Because the frequency distribution is a continuous representation of a histogram, the load duration curve is simply another arrangement of bin data.

In the frequency domain, or load duration curve form, the base load and peak load can be readily identified. Note that the practical base load at the "knee" of the curve is about 6.2 MW rather than the 4 MW absolute minimum identified on the load profile curve.

Sizing a cogenerator at baseload achieves the greatest efficiency and best use of capital. However, it may not offer the shortest payback because of the high value of electrical power. An appropriately sized CHP plant might be sized somewhat larger than base load to minimize payback time through increased electrical savings. A combination of load analysis and economic analysis must be performed to determine the most economical plant. For this example, the maximum economical plant size is arbitrarily assumed to be 8.5 MW. CHP systems sized this way produce high equipment utilization and depend on the utility to serve peak loads above the plant's 8.5 MW capacity.

The load duration curve allows the designer to estimate the total amount of steam generated within the interval. Because the total amount of steam is the area under the curve, the calculation may be performed by using either equations for rectangles and triangles or an appropriate curve analysis program. For a thermally tracked plant sized at the 6.2 MW baseload, the hours of operation are about 93 h per week. Therefore, based on the area under the rectangle, the total steam produced by the CHP plant is

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Cogenerated steam} &= (93\text{ h/week})(6.2\text{ MW})\\ &= 577\text{ MWh/week}\end{aligned}$$

If the plant is shut down during nonworking hours, no steam is wasted. In addition, if the electrical load profile is always above that needed to produce the 6.2 MW steam, the plant can run at full capacity for power and steam, while an electric utility provides peak power and a supplementary boiler provides peak steam. However, if the facility's steam load profile is unable to absorb the steam produced at continuous full power, electrical output can be reduced accordingly to avoid steam waste.

Where it is more cost-effective to generate excess power than to suffer the parasitic cost of condensing the steam, the plant can still be operated at full power. Therefore, it is important to examine whether the electrical load profile matches or exceeds the electrical output. If it does, then the load duration curve reveals the quality of boiler-generated steam required. This value, which can be estimated by calculating the size of the triangular area above the baseload, is

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Boiler steam required} &= 93(14 - 6.2)/2\\ &= 363\text{ MW/week (1300 GJ/week)}\end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Cogenerated kW} = (6200\text{ kW})/(\text{Steam-to-Electric Ratio})$$

where the ratio is that of the prime mover, in kW/kWh. The total weekly electrical production is

$$\text{Cogenerated kWh} = 6200\text{ kW/Ratio}$$

Fuel consumption equals cogenerated kilowatt-hours times the full-load heat in kilojoules, to which is added the boiler fuel consumption.

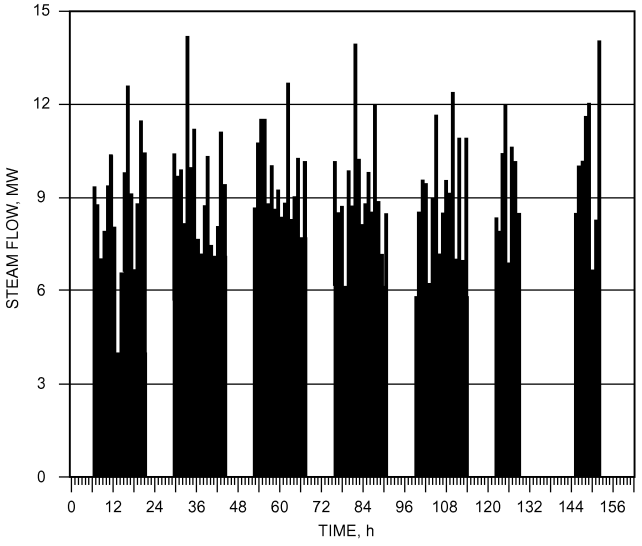


Fig. 67 Hypothetical Steam Load Profile

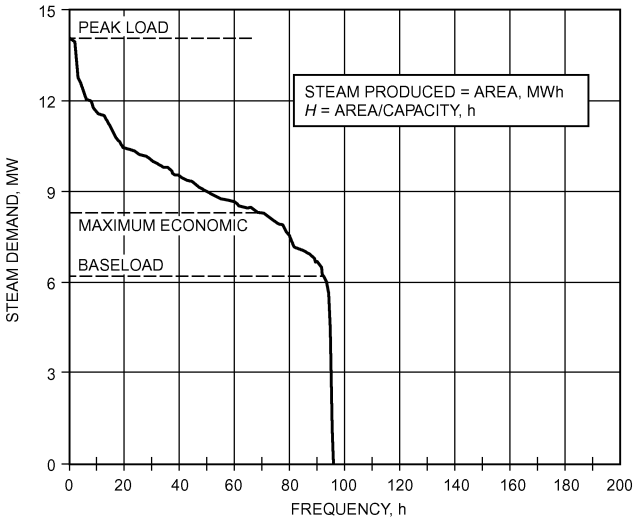


Fig. 68 Load Duration Curve

The **equivalent full-load hours (EFLH)** of both steam and electric CHP production in this base-load sizing and operating mode is 93 h per week, so that

Electric production = EFLH × Rated capacity (kW) at full load

If the plant had been sized at the maximum economic return, the cogenerated steam would be the area under the 8.5 MW level, or

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Cogenerated steam} &= 93 \times 6.2 + 70(8.5 - 6.2) \\ &\quad + (93 - 70)(8.5 - 6.2)/2 \\ &= 764 \text{ MWh/week}\end{aligned}$$

For this larger size, there is a higher electrical and lower boiler production, but some of the steam is condensed without any productive use.

Estimating the fuel consumption and electrical energy output of a system sized for the peak load or above the baseload is not as simple as for the base-load design because changes in the prime mover's performance at part load must be considered. In this case, average value estimates of performance at part load must be used for preliminary studies.

In some cases, an installation has only one prime mover; however, several smaller units operating in parallel provide increased reliability and performance during part-load operation. Figure 69 shows the use of three prime movers rated at 3 MW each. For this example, generators #1 and #2 operate fully loaded, and #3 operates between full-load capacity and 50% capacity while tracking facility thermal demand. Because operation at less than 50% load is inefficient, further reduction in total output must be achieved by part-load operation of generators #1 and #2.

The advantages of multiple units come at their higher specific investment and maintenance costs, the control complexity, and the usually lower efficiency of smaller units.

Facilities such as hospitals often seek to reduce their utility costs by using existing standby generators to share the electrical peak (peak shaving). Such an operation is not strictly CHP because heat recovery is rarely justified. Figure 70 shows a hypothetical electrical load duration curve with frequency as a percent of total hours in the year (8760). A generator rated at 1000 kW, for example, reduces the peak demand by 500 kW if it is operated between 500 and 1000 kW to avoid extended hours of low-efficiency operation.

Operating the generator can save some electrical energy and reduce demand. However, this saving is idealistic because it can only be obtained if the operators or control system can anticipate when facility demand will exceed 1400 kW in time to bring the generator up to operating condition. The peak shaver should not be started too early, because it would waste fuel.

Also, many utilities include ratchet clauses in their rate schedules. As a result, if the peak-shaving generator is inoperative for any reason when the facility's monthly peak occurs, the ratchet is set for a year hence, and the demand savings potential of the peaking generator will not be realized until a year later. Even though an existing standby generator may seem to offer "free" peak shaving capacity, careful planning and operation are required to secure its full potential.

Conversely, continuous-duty/standby systems offer the benefits of heat recovery while satisfying the facility's standby requirements. During emergencies, the generator load is switched from its normal nonessential load to the emergency load.

Two-Dimensional Load Duration Curve

A two-dimensional load duration curve becomes necessary when the designer must consider simultaneous steam and electrical load variations, such as when facility electrical demand drops below the output of a steam-tracking generator, and the excess power capacity cannot be exported. During these periods, the generator is throttled to curtail electrical output to match facility demand (i.e., it operates in electrical tracking mode).

To develop the two-dimensional load duration curve method for simultaneous loads, either the electrical or steam demand must be broken into discrete periods defined by the number of hours per year when the demand is within a certain range of values, or bins.

Duration curves for the remaining load are then created for each period as before, using coincident values. Figure 71 shows such a representation for three bins. The electrical load values indicated in the figure represent the center value of each bin. In general, a large number of periods gives a more accurate representation of facility loads. Also, the greater the load fluctuation, the greater the number of periods required for accurate representation. Note that the total number of hours for all periods adds up to 8760, the total number of hours in a year.

Another situation that requires a two-dimensional load duration curve is when the facility buys or sells power, the price of which depends on the time of day or time of the year. Many electric rate structures contain explicit time periods for the purchase or sale of power. In some cases, there is only a summer/winter distinction. Other rate schedules may have several periods to reflect time-of-

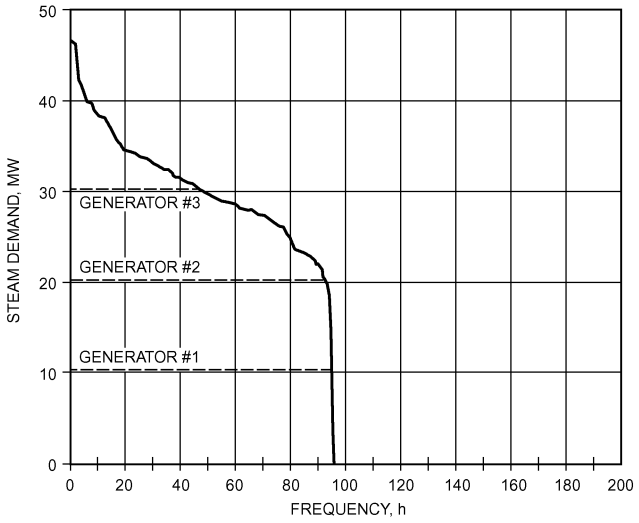


Fig. 69 Load Duration Curve with Multiple Generators

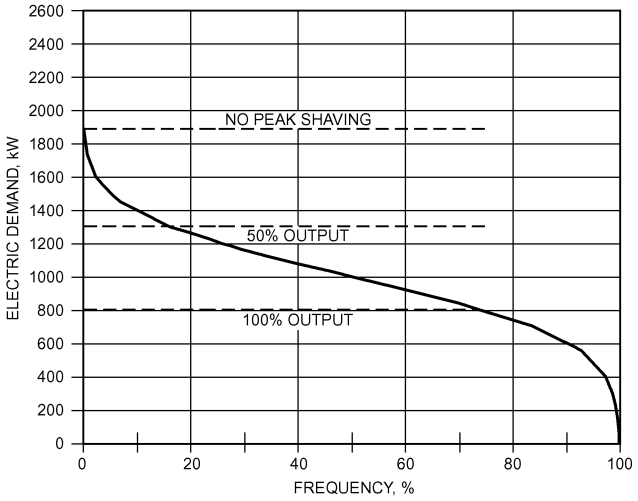


Fig. 70 Hypothetical Peaking Generator

use or time-of-sale rates. The two-dimensional analysis is required to consider these rate schedule periods when defining the load bins because the operating schedule with the greatest annual savings is influenced by energy prices as well as energy demands.

Using Figure 71 as an illustration of a summer-peaking utility, the first two bins might coincide with the winter/fall/spring off-peak rate and the third bin with the on-peak rate. Because analysis becomes burdensome when there are large load swings and several rate periods, the calculations are run by computers.

Analysis by Simulations

The load duration curve is a convenient, intuitive graphical tool for preliminary sizing and analysis of a CHP system; it lacks the capability, however, for detailed analysis. A commercial or institutional facility, for example, can have as many as four different loads that must be considered simultaneously: cooling, noncooling electrical, steam or high-temperature hot water for space heating, and low-temperature service hot water. These loads are never in balance at any instant, which complicates sizing equipment, establishing operating modes, and determining the quantity of heat rejected from the cogenerator that is usefully applied to the facility loads.

The fact that prime movers rarely operate at full rated load further complicates evaluation of commercial systems; therefore, part-load operating characteristics such as fuel consumption, exhaust mass flow, exhaust temperature, and heat rejected from the jacket and intercooler of internal combustion engines must be considered. If the prime mover is a combustion gas turbine, then the effects of ambient temperature on full-load capacity and part-load fuel consumption and exhaust characteristics (or on cooling capacity if gas turbine inlet air cooling is used) should be considered.

In addition to the prime movers, a commercial or institutional CHP system may include absorption chillers that use jacket and exhaust heat to produce chilled water at two different COPs. Some commercial systems use thermal energy storage to store hot water, chilled water, or ice to reduce the recovered thermal energy that must be dumped during periods of low demand. Internal combustion engines coupled with steam compressors and steam-injected gas turbines have been used to allow some variability of the output heat/power ratio from a single package.

Computer screening programs that analyze CHP systems are readily available. Many of these programs emphasize the financial aspects of CHP with elaborate rate structures, energy price forecasts, and economic models. Others emphasize equipment part-load performance, load schedules, and other technical characteristics.

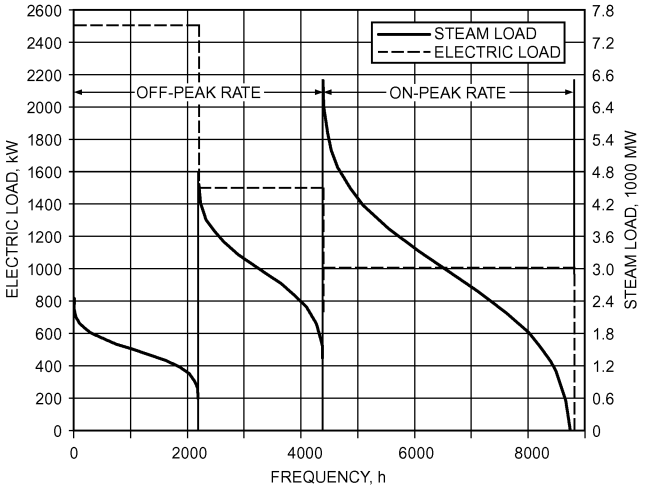


Fig. 71 Example of Two-Dimensional Load Duration Curve

Although these programs can be useful, they do not remove the need for detailed analysis before undertaking a project.

The primary consideration in selecting a computer program for analyzing commercial CHP technical feasibility is the ability to handle multiple, time-varying loads. The four methods of modeling the thermal and electrical loads are as follows:

- Hourly average values for a complete year
- Monthly average values
- Truncated year consisting of hourly averaged values for one or more typical (usually working and nonworking) days of each month
- Bin methods

CHP simulation using hourly averaged values for load representation provides the greatest accuracy; however, the 8760 values for each type of load can make managing load data a formidable task. Guinn (1987) describes a public-domain simulation that can consider a full year of multiple-load data.

The data needed to perform a monthly averaged load representation can often be obtained from utility billings. This model should only be used as an initial analysis; accuracy is greatest when thermal and electric profiles are relatively consistent.

The truncated-year model is a compromise between the accuracy offered by the full hourly model and the minimal data-handling requirements of the monthly average model. It involves developing hourly values for each load over a typical average day of each month. Usually, two typical days are considered: working and nonworking. Thus, instead of 8760 values to represent a load over a year, only 576 values are required. This type of load model is often used in CHP computer programs. Pedreyra (1988) and Somasundaram (1986) describe programs that use this method of load modeling.

Bin methods are based on the frequency distribution, or histogram, of load values. This method determines the number of hours per year the load was in different ranges, or bins. This method of representing weather data is widely used to perform building energy analysis. It is a convenient way to condense a large database into a smaller set of values, but it is no more accurate than the time resolution of the original set. Furthermore, bin methods become unacceptably cumbersome for CHP analysis if more than two loads must be considered.

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CHAPTER 8

COMBUSTION TURBINE INLET COOLING

Advantages 8.2
Disadvantages 8.3
Definition and Theory 8.3
System Types 8.3
Calculation of Power Capacity Enhancement and Economics 8.6

COMBUSTION turbines produce over one-third of U.S. electric energy requirements (GTA 2022). They not only provide baseload power but also support intermittent production of electricity from renewable resources. According to Mooney (2016), every 0.88% of capacity from renewables needs 1% capacity backup from a fast-reacting fossil-fuel system. Combustion turbines are efficient prime movers for production of electricity and thermal energy. Turbine inlet cooling increases the capacity and efficiency of combustion turbines during hot weather, when electric power is most in demand. The increased output and higher efficiency of combustion turbines in all configurations, including combined heat and power, minimizes the need for operating less-efficient systems and thus provides a path for decarbonization of energy systems (Punwani 2022).

Power output capacity of all combustion turbines (CTs) varies with ambient air temperature and site elevation. The rated capacities of all CTs are based on standard ambient air at 15°C, 60% rh, 101.35 kPa at sea level, and zero inlet and exhaust pressure drops, as selected by the International Organization for Standardization (ISO). For all CTs, increased ambient air temperature or site elevation decreases power output; increased ambient air temperature also reduces fuel efficiency (i.e., increases the heat rate, defined as fuel energy required per unit of electric energy produced). However, the extent of the effect of these changes on output and efficiency varies with CT design. This chapter provides a detailed discussion on combustion turbine inlet cooling (CTIC). Additional information on applying CTIC to combined heat and power systems (cogeneration) is provided in Chapter 7.

There are two types of CTs: aeroderivative and industrial/frame. Figures 1 and 2 show typical effects of ambient air temperature on power output and heat rate, respectively, for these types of turbines. The actual performance of a specific CT at different inlet air temperatures depends on its design. Figures 1 and 2 show that aeroderivative CTs are more sensitive to ambient air temperature than are industrial/frame CTs. Figure 1 (Punwani and Hurlbert 2005) shows that, for a typical aeroderivative CT, an increase in inlet air temperature from 15 to 38°C on a hot summer day decreases power output to about 81% of its rated capacity: a loss of 19% of the rated capacity. Figure 2 (Punwani 2003) shows that, for the same change in ambient air temperature, the heat rate of a typical aeroderivative CT increases (i.e., fuel efficiency decreases) by about 4% of the rated heat rate at ISO conditions. Increasingly, industrial/frame CTs are using aeroderivative technology to improve performance; thus, their performance curves are moving toward those of the classic aeroderivative CT.

In cogeneration and combined-cycle systems that use thermal energy in CT exhaust gases for steam generation, heating, cooling, or more power generation, increases in ambient air temperature also reduce the total thermal energy available for these applications, as shown in Figure 3 (Orlando 1996).

CTs in simple- and combined-cycle systems are particularly qualified to meet peak electricity demand because of their ability to start and stop more quickly than steam-turbine-based thermal power generation systems using coal, oil or gas, and nuclear plants. For fossil fuel power generation, combined-cycle systems are the most fuel efficient (lowest heat rate of typically 7400 kJ/kWh) and steam-turbine-based systems are the least efficient (highest heat rate range between 12 660 and 21 100 kJ/kWh, depending on turbine age). A typical heat rate for a simple-cycle system is about 10 550 kJ/kWh. Therefore, to minimize fuel cost for power generation, the preferred order of dispatching power to meet market demand is to operate combined-cycle systems first, simple-cycle systems next, and older and oil-fired steam turbines as the last resort.

Electric power demand is generally high when ambient temperatures are high. An example of an hourly profile of ambient temperature, system load, and CT output is shown in Figure 4 (Punwani and Hurlbert 2005).

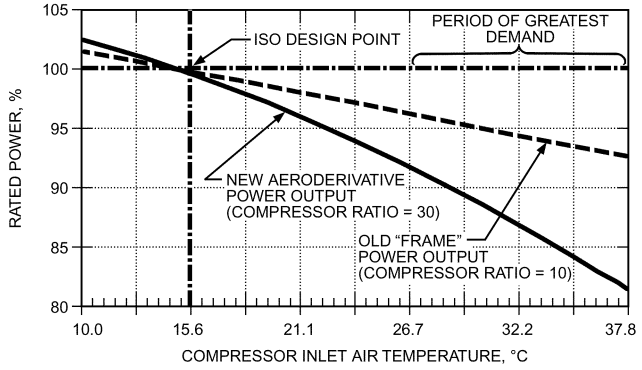

Fig. 1 Effect of Ambient Temperature on CT Output
(Punwani and Hurlbert 2005)

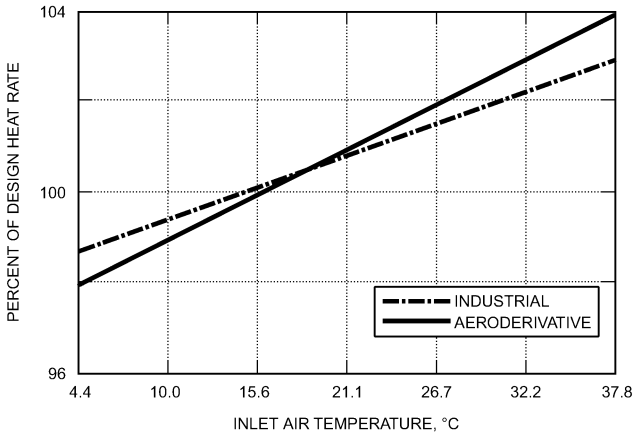

Fig. 2 Effect of Ambient Temperature on CT Heat Rate
(Punwani 2003)

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 1.10, Cogeneration Systems.

When high ambient temperatures drive up power demand, the use of less efficient (high-fuel-cost) generation plants is required, and that drives up the market price of electric energy. Figure 5 (Hilberg 2006) shows the hourly load profile in one U.S. region for a single day in the summer. Although the peak electricity demand increases by 80%, the peak power price increases by over 400%. Figures 4 and 5 show that power output capacity decreases just when it is most needed, and when power is also most valuable.

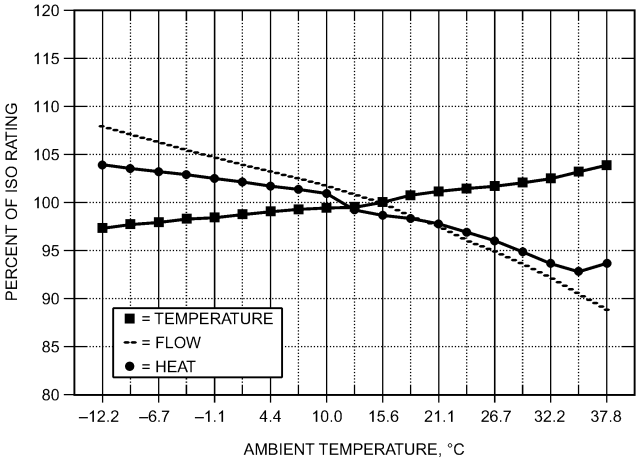

Fig. 3 Effects of Ambient Temperature on Thermal Energy, Mass Flow Rate, and Temperature of CT Exhaust Gases
(Orlando 1996)

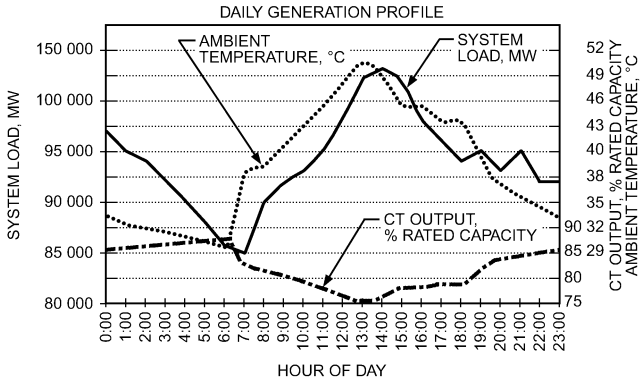

Fig. 4 Typical Hourly Power Demand Profile
(Punwani and Hurlbert 2005)

The trends shown in Figures 4 and 5 are not unique to the United States. The Middle East is seeing much higher growth rates in power demand, and that demand is also directly linked to hot-weather power usage. In some countries in the Middle East, over 40% of power usage is linked to air conditioning.

CTIC is used by thousands of CT-based power plants to overcome the ill effects of increased ambient temperature on CT performance. It can provide economic and environmental benefits for plant owners, ratepayers, and the general public.

1. ADVANTAGES

CTIC offers economic as well as environmental benefits.

Economic Benefits

- Maximizes power output when most needed and most valuable during hot weather
- Reduces capital cost ($/kW) for incremental capacity
- Increases CT fuel efficiency (lowers heat rate)
- Minimizes the need to operate less-efficient, more carbon intensive "peaker" systems to support the electric grid, thus providing a pathway for decarbonization of the energy system.
- Reduces emissions of pollutants (SO_x, NO_x, particulates, and hydrocarbons)
- Minimizes the need to install new power plants (and related siting issues) to meet peak grid demand during hot weather

There are four major types of thermal power generation systems:

- Combined heat and power (CHP) or cogeneration
- Combined cycle (CC)
- Simple cycle (SC)
- Steam turbine (ST)

Electric power generation efficiencies of these systems are typically in the ranges of 48 to 55% (i.e., heat rates of 6900 to 7400 kJ/kWh) for combined cycle, 34 to 42% (i.e., heat rates of 8500 to 10 550 kJ/kWh) for simple cycle, and 23 to 28% (i.e., heat rates of 12 700 to 15 600 kJ/kWh) for steam turbine. Even though the electric power generation efficiency of a CHP system is similar to that

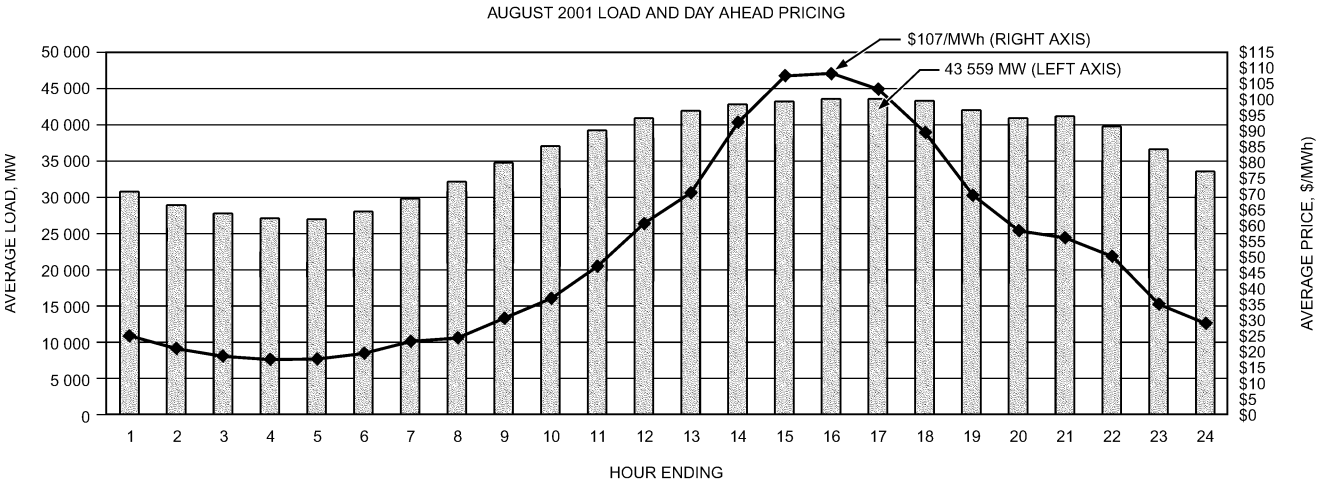

Fig. 5 Example of Daily System Load and Electric Energy Pricing Profiles
(Hilberg 2006)

Table 1 Typical Combined-Cycle, Simple-Cycle, and Steam Turbine Systems

Unit Type	Turbine Inlet Cooling Candidates			Existing Older Plants Steam Turbine
	CHP/Cogeneration	Combined-Cycle CT	Simple-Cycle CT	
Prime mover	Frame CT	Frame CT-STG	Frame CT	Condensing STG[d]
Fuel	Gas	Gas	Gas	No. 6 Oil
Plant age, yr	<5	<5	<5	>30
Heat rate, kJ/kWh	11 340	7385	11 340	13 715
Generation capacity, MW	100	100	100	100
Hours of operation	1	1	1	1
Thermal energy need, MW	136	136	136	136
Fuel use, MW (HHV)[a]				
Power generation	315	205	315	380
Thermal energy[b]	0	160	160	160
Total	315	365	475	540
Energy efficiency, %				
Electric power generation	32	49	32	26
Overall	75	65	50	44
Carbon emissions,[c] Mg/h	15.4	18.0	23.3	26.6

[a]HHV = higher heating value.
[b]CHP system provides thermal energy from the CT exhaust gases without using additional fuel. Other systems use 85% energy efficiency boiler for providing thermal energy needs.
[c]Assuming natural gas of HHV of 37 260 kJ/m^3.
[d]STG = steam turbine generator.

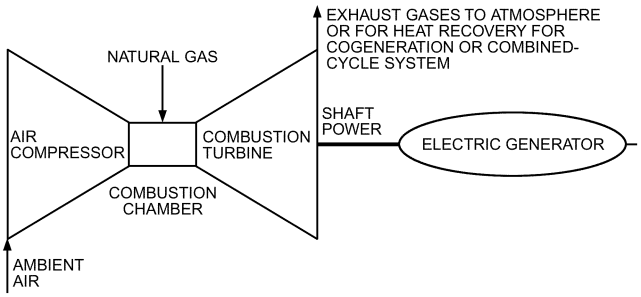

Fig. 6 Schematic Flow Diagram of Typical Combustion Turbine System

of a CC or an SC system, its overall energy utilization efficiency is the highest for simultaneously producing electricity and thermal energy, as shown in the ex-ample in Table 1. In this example, the CHP system uses the same CT as the simple-cycle system but has the lowest carbon dioxide emissions, followed by the carbon emissions from the CC, SC, and ST systems. Therefore, to maximize the decarbonization of the energy system, it is desirable to maximize the use of CHP systems. CTIC of a CHP system not only increases the electric power output but also increases the available thermal energy by increasing the mass flow rate of exhaust gases (Punwani 2011, 2012).

During hot weather, maximum use of CTIC of CHP systems minimizes the need to operate CC systems to meet grid demand. Likewise, maximizing CTIC for CC systems reduces the need to run SC systems, and maximizing CTIC for SC systems reduces the need to run ST systems. Therefore, CTIC is a pathway for decarbonization of energy systems.

2. DISADVANTAGES

- Permanently higher CT inlet pressure drop that results in a small drop in the CT output capacity even when CTIC is not being used (magnitude of pressure drop varies with CTIC technology)
- Additional maintenance cost for CTIC equipment

3. DEFINITION AND THEORY

A schematic flow diagram of a combustion turbine (CT) system is shown in Figure 6.

Power output of a CT is directly proportional to and limited by the mass flow rate of the compressed air available to it from the air compressor that provides high-pressure air to the combustion chamber of the CT system. An air compressor has a fixed capacity for handling a volumetric flow rate of air for a given rotational speed of the compressor. Even though the volumetric capacity of a compressor remains constant, the mass flow rate of air it delivers to the CT changes with ambient air temperature. The mass flow rate of air decreases as the air density decreases with increasing ambient temperature. CTIC reduces the inlet air temperature, resulting in increases in air density mass flow rate and power output. For more details, consult Stewart (1999).

4. SYSTEM TYPES

Many technologies are commercially available for CTIC (Punwani 2012, 2014), but the overall approaches can be divided into the following major groups:

- Evaporative systems
- Chiller systems
- Liquefied natural gas (LNG) vaporization systems
- Hybrid systems

Each approach has advantages and disadvantages; for more information, see Stewart (1999).

Psychrometric paths for various CTIC technologies are shown in Figure 7.

Evaporative Systems

Evaporative cooling systems rely on cooling produced by evaporation of water added into the inlet air. An ideal evaporative cooling process occurs at a constant wet-bulb temperature and cools the air to a higher relative humidity (i.e., water vapor content increases). When the warm ambient inlet air comes in contact with the added water, it transfers some of its heat to the liquid water and evaporates some of the water. The process of heat transfer from inlet air to water cools the inlet air. Water added in the evaporative systems also acts as an air washer by cleaning the inlet air stream of airborne particulates and soluble gases, which could be a significant benefit to downstream filter elements. Studies show that evaporative cooling also reduces NO_x emissions because of the increase in moisture added to the air. The psychrometry of CTIC using evaporative systems has been described in detail by Stewart (1999).

Evaporative systems can cool the inlet air up to 98% of the difference between the ambient dry-bulb and wet-bulb temperatures. Therefore, the most cooling can be achieved during hot and/or dry

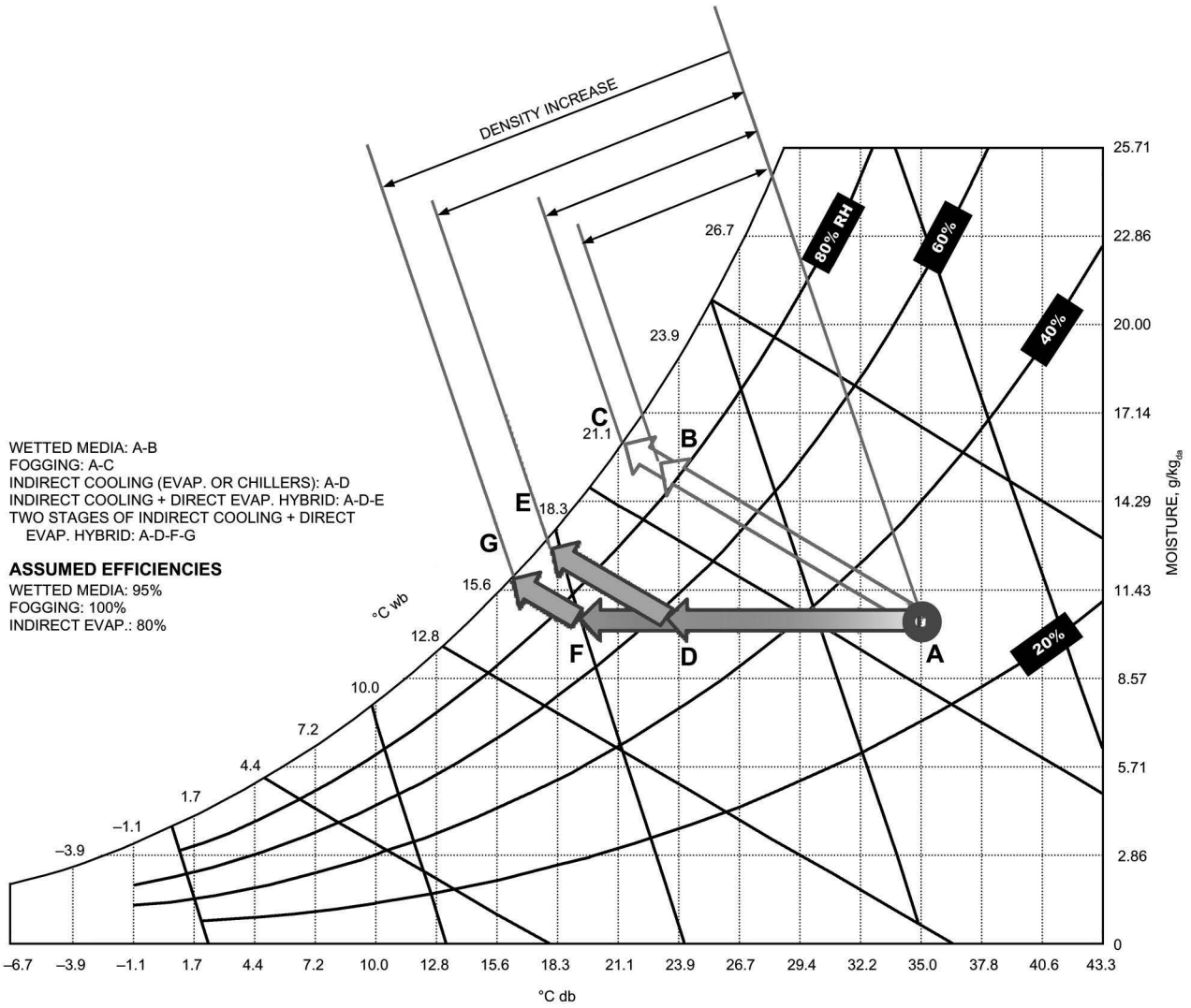

Fig. 7 Psychrometric Chart Showing Direct and Indirect Inlet Air Cooling Processes
(Schlom and Bastianen 2009)

weather. Design and hourly temperatures for many locations can be found on the CD accompanying Chapter 14 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, Handbook Online, and on the *International Weather for Energy Calculations 2.0 (IWEC2) DVD* (ASHRAE 2012). This information is useful in evaluating the cooling potential for locations in many climates.

Evaporative systems have the lowest capital costs among CTIC systems, and are the most common type in use. Their primary disadvantage is that the extent of cooling produced is limited by the wet-bulb temperature (and thus, cooling is weather dependent). In arid climates, these systems consume large quantities of water (e.g., 0.3 L/min to cool 5 m^3/s of air by 10 K), which comprises the major component of the system operating cost.

There are two types of evaporative systems: direct and indirect.

Direct Evaporative Cooling. Direct evaporative system types in commercial use are wetted media and fogging.

Wetted Media. As the first technology adopted for CTIC, these systems have a long history of success in a wide range of operating climates. Inlet air is exposed to a thin film of water on the extended surface of honeycomb-like wetted media (Zeller 2012, 2014). Figure 8 shows a typical wetted media.

Water used for wetting may or may not require treatment, depending on its quality and the medium manufacturer's specifications.

Typical pressure drop across the wetted media is about 75 Pa. The higher the degree of saturation required, the more media required and higher the pressure drop. A wetted-media system requires proper control of the chemistry of recirculating water (e.g., contaminant absorption) and monitoring of media degradation (Graef 2004). The media may need to be replaced every 5 to 10 years, depending on water quality, air quality, and hours of operation.

Fogging. This technology adds moisture to the inlet air by spraying very fine droplets of water (Shepherd 2012, 2014), as shown in Figure 9.

High-pressure fogging systems can be designed to produce droplets of variable sizes, depending on the desired evaporation time and ambient conditions. The water droplet size is generally less than 40 μm, and averages about 20 μm. Fogging systems typically require higher-quality water than wetted-media systems do. Generally, reverse-osmosis or demineralized water is used to ensure cleanliness throughout the system. Typical pressure drop across the fogging section is about 25 Pa. Fogging nozzles may need to be replaced every 5 to 10 years because of erosion. The high-pressure pumps require servicing at least annually.

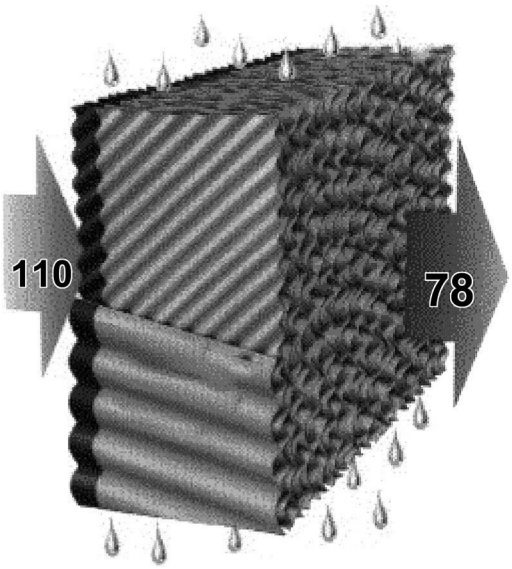

Fig. 8 Typical Wetted Media
(Zeller 2014)

Fig. 9 Water Fog Created for Fogging System
(Shepherd 2014)

A fogging system that sprays more water than could evaporate before the inlet air enters the compressor is known as a **wet compression**, **overspray**, **high-fogging**, or **over-fogging system** (Jolly et al. 2005; Kraft 2004; Schwieger 2004; Shepherd 2013, 2015a, 2015b). Water in excess of that required by fogging does not significantly further reduce inlet air temperature. It is ingested into the compressor section of the CT, and provides the following benefits:

- The additional water evaporates in the compression stages of the compressor, allowing the compressor to be cooler and require less work for air compression.
- The excess water increases the total mass flow rate of gases entering the CT and helps increase power output beyond that possible with fogging alone.

There is debate in the industry whether wet compression is truly a CTIC technology; accordingly, this chapter addresses only the inlet fogging contribution of the wet compression technology.

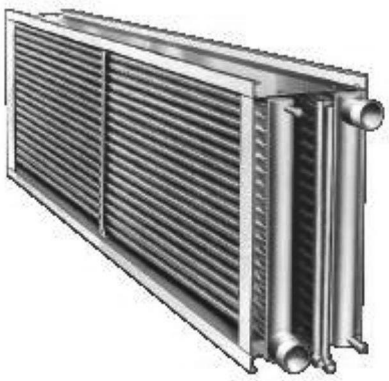

Fig. 10 Cooling Coil Used for Indirect Cooling Chiller Systems
(Courtesy of Aerofin)

Indirect Evaporative Cooling. An indirect evaporative cooling (IEC) CTIC system cools inlet air by indirect heat exchange with a stream of air or water that has been cooled by direct evaporative cooling (Bastianen 2013). Its psychrometric path is the same as that of indirect cooling using chillers: it reduces both the dry- and wet-bulb temperatures of the air. The only difference is the primary source of cooling.

IEC has some advantages: it (1) imposes less parasitic load than a chiller system, and (2) delivers higher-density air than a direct-cooling system, because no water is added to the inlet air.

Lowering the wet-bulb temperature of the inlet air allows it to be direct-evaporatively cooled to a lower dry-bulb temperature than that possible by only direct evaporative cooling of the ambient air, without first using indirect cooling, as shown in an example in Figure 7.

An IEC system also has some disadvantages:

- It cannot reduce the dry-bulb temperature as low as that possible with chiller systems, especially under high humidity
- Compared to direct evaporative cooling alone, IEC achieves less temperature (dry-bulb) reduction and requires the additional capital cost of an indirect heat exchanger
- Total parasitic load is higher, compared to chiller and direct-evaporative systems alone, because of the power required for pushing the airstreams through the heat exchanger and the direct evaporative cooling sections

Chiller Systems

Chiller systems cool inlet air by exchange of heat through indirect or direct contact between warm ambient inlet air and a cold fluid produced by chillers. In **indirect heat exchange systems**, chilled fluid flows inside a coil (Figure 10) while the inlet air flows across the coil face (Sims 2014; Tillman 2013). Typical inlet-air-side pressure drop across the heat exchange coil is about 250 Pa. The water vapor content (humidity ratio) of the inlet air remains constant as its dry-bulb temperature decreases. Ammonia is the most commonly used chilled fluid in direct refrigerant applications; for indirect-contact heat exchange systems, the preferred chilled fluid is often water, though water/glycol, HFCs, HCFCs, and other aqueous fluids are also used.

A **direct heat exchange system** (also known as a **bulk air cooler**) uses wetted media in combination with chillers, and allows the flexibility of using wetted media either with ambient temperature water or with chilled water, depending on the desired power output capacity (Liebendorfer and Furlong 2008). A direct-contact heat exchanger operating without chilling the added water performs

just as a wetted-media evaporative system does, except that the pressure drop is about 200 Pa. Stewart (1999) describes the psychrometry of CTIC for chilled-fluid systems in detail.

The primary advantage of chiller systems is that they can cool inlet air to much lower temperatures (thus enhancing power output capacity more than evaporative cooling systems can), and can, if sized to do so, maintain any desired inlet air temperature down to 5.6°C, independent of ambient dry-bulb and wet-bulb temperature. Additional inlet air cooling of up to 4 to 6 K may occur in the bellmouth section of the air compressor inlet housing, depending on housing design; during hot and humid weather, this additional temperature drop may be enough to cause the temperature of moisture-saturated air to fall below 0°C and form ice crystals, which could damage compressor blades. If, however, the ambient air is very dry, inlet air could be cooled below 5.6°C (Stewart 2001).

The primary disadvantages of chiller systems are that their installed costs and inlet air pressure drops (which lead to power loss even when CTIC is not being used) are much higher than those for evaporative systems. Chiller systems could be air or water cooled; water-cooled is the most common. Most water-cooled chiller systems require cooling towers, although some directly use seawater. Systems that use cooling towers require makeup water, which may require treatment, although usually less than is required by evaporative systems. Makeup water required for cooling towers is about 2 to 3 L/s per 5000 kW of chiller capacity. During hot, humid weather, most chiller systems produce saturated air and require mist eliminators downstream of the cooling to minimize the potential for water carryover from the cooling coil. It is also common to collect the condensate that forms on the inlet air coils; this can offset a substantial portion of the cooling tower makeup water requirements.

Chiller systems can use mechanical and/or absorption chillers, with or without thermal energy storage (TES).

Mechanical chillers used in CTIC systems could be centrifugal, screw, or reciprocating, and could driven by electric motors, steam turbines, or engines. These chillers can use CFCs, HCFCs, or ammonia as a refrigerant and can cool the inlet air to 5.6°C (or below, if desired) without the risk of forming ice crystals. Installed cost of motor-driven mechanical chillers is lower than that for any other chiller, but their parasitic loads are the highest: 0.17 to 0.23 kW/kW of refrigeration. Mechanical chillers driven by steam turbines or engines have lower parasitic electrical loads (0.0085 kW/kW), but require fuel or heat inputs and have a higher installed cost. Mechanical chillers are more commonly used for CTIC than are absorption chillers.

Absorption chillers require thermal energy from steam, hot water, hot exhaust gases, or natural gas as the primary source of energy, and need much less electric energy than mechanical chillers. If water is used as the refrigerant, as is most common for CTIC, inlet air can be cooled to about 10°C; if ammonia is the refrigerant, air temperatures will be similar to those available using mechanical chillers.

Absorption chillers can be single or double effect. Single-effect absorption chillers use hot water or 103 kPa (gage) steam [0.0006 kg/(s·kW)], whereas double-effect chillers require less steam [0.00035 kg/(s·kW)] but need it at higher pressure [typically 793 kPa (gage)]. The advantage of an absorption chiller system is that it has much less parasitic electric load (typically, 0.0085 kW/kW), but its capital cost is higher than that for mechanical chiller systems. The cost of the net kilowatt capacity enhancement provided by these chillers could be comparable.

Their main successful application is in power plants where excess waste thermal energy is available, and where use of this energy saves higher-value electric energy.

Thermal energy storage (TES) is used in chilled-fluid systems to increase the available net power output capacity during on-peak periods. It is typically used when only a limited number of hours per day require inlet air cooling, or when peak power enhancement is highly valued (Frankenfield 2013, 2015). TES systems incorporate tanks that store chilled fluid or ice, which is produced by chillers or refrigeration systems during off-peak periods, when the market value of electric energy is low. The stored chilled water or ice is used to cool the inlet air during on-peak periods, when the value of electric energy is high. The primary advantage of a TES system is that it can reduce total system capital cost by reducing chiller capacity requirements from that required to match the instantaneous on-peak demand for cooling. It also increases on-peak capacity and revenues for the power plant, because little or no electric energy is required to operate the chillers during the high-demand, high-value, on-peak periods. The disadvantage of a TES system is that it requires a larger site footprint for the TES tank.

There are two types of TES systems: full and partial shift. In **full-shift systems**, chillers are not operated during on-peak periods; all the required cooling is achieved by using the chilled fluid or ice from the TES tank. In **partial-shift systems**, the downsized chiller system also runs during on-peak periods to complement the cooling capacity available from the stored chilled fluid or ice.

Several publications compare the performance and economics of TES options for CTIC (Andrepont 1994) or provide methodology for their analysis (Andrepont and Pasteris 2003) and case studies (Liebendorfer and Andrepont 2005). A database of TES-CTIC applications has been developed and analyzed, illustrating the trends in TES-CTIC technology, capacity, and geographic locales, as well as demonstrating the performance and economic advantages of combining TES with TIC in many applications (Andrepont 2005).

LNG Vaporization Systems

These systems are useful for power plants located near a liquefied natural gas (LNG) import facility. In supplying natural gas for pipelines, power plants, or other applications, LNG must be vaporized by some heat source. For applications in CTIC, the inlet air is used as such a heat source. Cho et al. (2003) and Punwani and Pasteris (2004) give examples of LNG vaporization systems.

Hybrid Systems

Hybrid systems combine at least two technologies, which can be used simultaneously in a sequential process; in some systems, each technology may also be used individually (Punwani 2010).

5. CALCULATION OF POWER CAPACITY ENHANCEMENT AND ECONOMICS

A CTIC system's power capacity enhancement and economics depends on several parameters, including the following:

- CT design and characteristics
  - CT heat rate versus compressor inlet air temperature
  - CT power output versus compressor inlet air temperature
  - CT airflow (not an independent variable; dependent on compressor inlet air temperature)
- CTIC design characteristics
  - Parasitic load
  - Pressure drop across the component inserted upstream of the compressor (insertion loss)
  - Water usage
- Hourly weather data (dry-bulb and coincident wet-bulb temperatures) for the geographic location of the CT
- Selected ambient design conditions
- Selected cooled air temperature upstream of compressor
- Cost of fuel
- Cost of water
- Power demand profile
- Hourly market value of electric energy
- Hourly market value of plant capacity

One parameter needed to estimate the capacity and efficiency enhancements by CTIC is an estimate of the degree of cooling achieved.

Direct Evaporative Cooling. Cooling achieved is easily calculated for all of the systems.

Media and fogger evaporative coolers cool a percentage of the difference between wet-bulb (WB) and dry-bulb (DB) temperatures:

$$\text{Degrees of cooling} = \text{Cooling efficiency} \times (\text{DB} - \text{WB})$$

The *ASHRAE Design Guide for Combustion Turbine Inlet Cooling* (Punwani et al. 2022) shows step-by-step calculations for estimating the net capacity enhancement and heat rate reduction (efficiency enhancement) potential of media and fogger evaporative coolers, after accounting for all parasitic loads. The examples show performance of evaporative cooling technologies for two regions: one with high humidity (Houston, TX), and one with low humidity (Las Vegas, NV).

Indirect Evaporative Cooling. Indirect evaporative cooling typically achieves 1 to 3 K of cooling less than direct evaporative cooling does.

Chiller-Based Cooling. Chillers are sized to cool to the selected design temperature:

$$\text{CCL} = AF_m(H_a - H_c)$$

where

CCL = chiller cooling load, kW
AF_m = mass flow rate of cooled air, kg/s
H_a = enthalpy of ambient air, kJ/kg
H_c = enthalpy of cooled air, kJ/kg

Parasitic Loss. Parasitic loss is the power required to run the CTIC system.

Media evaporative coolers consume the same amount of power any time the pump is energized, regardless of cooling produced. The total power required varies depending on pumping head, pressure drop of valves, and other restrictions, but a reasonable estimate is 0.01 W/(m^3 · s).

Fogging systems power consumption is a function of the amount of water injected into the air, and water pressure. For a water pressure of 20 MPa, the parasitic loss is approximately 0.01 kW/(L · s).

Parasitic power loss in indirect evaporative systems must account for two parasitic loads:

- Fan and pump power for direct evaporative cooling of a large flow rate of secondary air (i.e., air that does not enter the CT)
- Power associated with increased inlet pressure loss for primary air (i.e., air that enters the CT) through the indirect heat exchanger

Chillers consume power based on the cooling load and condenser temperature.

$$\text{Electric chiller parasitic load, kW} = 0.2 \times \text{CCL}$$

For single- and double-effect absorption chillers, use the appropriate power need (kW/kW).

The cooling load of the cooling tower (CTL), in kW, is 125% of the chiller load. Estimate the water flow rate capacity (CTC) of the cooling tower at a rate of 0.2 L/s × CTL. The power of the pump and fan is estimated by the following equation:

$$\text{Tower parasitic load, kW} = 0.04 \times \text{CTL}$$

For air-cooled chillers, power usage is greater than for water-cooled chillers, and is a function of the dry-bulb (rather than wet-bulb) ambient air temperature.

Punwani et al. (2022) provides step-by-step calculations for estimating the net capacity enhancement and heat rate reduction (efficiency enhancement) potential of a chiller system, after accounting for all parasitic loads, in regions with high and low humidity (Houston, TX, and Las Vegas, NV, respectively).

For chillers integrated with TES, most or all of the chiller parasitic load (excluding some water pumps) can be eliminated during peak periods of CTIC operation, with the chiller operating (and the associated parasitic load) during off-peak times of lower power demand and lower power value. For step-by-step calculations for estimating net capacity enhancement and heat rate reduction (efficiency enhancement) of chillers integrated with full-shift and partial-shift TES systems, see Punwani et al. (2022).

Insertion Loss. All CTs have an insertion loss, which reduces the turbine's power output by approximately 1% per kPa of pressure differential across the inserted component. The pressure differential for the evaporative cooler when no water is being injected (cooler not in operation) is about half as much as when it is running. Insertion loss on a cooling coil also decreases when it is not running or there is no condensate on the coil.

Net and Gross Power Increase. Figure 1 shows typical power degradation caused by increased ambient temperature. For a new aeroderivative CT, power can be lost or restored at an estimated rate of 0.79% per K of temperature change. Using these numbers, the power output of the CT can be estimated with and without CTIC. The gross power increase is the difference between these two values. The net power increase is the gross increase less all parasitic loads.

Fuel Usage. Figure 2 shows the change in heat rate with increase in inlet air temperature. The curve for the industrial turbine can be estimated to be 0.14% per K. Fuel usage of the CT at ISO standard conditions ranges between 8500 and 12 600 kJ/kWh.

Fuel usage must be calculated for the turbine with and without cooling. Fuel consumption is greater (but more efficient) when the air has been cooled, and the cost of this additional fuel should be deducted from the gross increase in revenue.

Water Usage. Water is often a precious commodity at industrial sites. Usage can be estimated as follows.

For media and fogging evaporative coolers, water usage is a function of the amount of cooling and the airflow:

$$\text{Water usage, L/min} = \frac{0.03 \times \Delta t \times AF_v}{60}$$

where

Δt = degrees of cooling, °C
AF_v = volumetric airflow rate, L/min

Water evaporation can also be calculated by multiplying the difference in kilograms of moisture of the entering (v_1) and leaving (v_2) air times the mass per minute of airflow:

$$\text{Evaporation, L/min} = \frac{(v_2 - v_1) \times AF_m}{1 \text{ kg/L}}$$

Bleedoff from media evaporative coolers should be added to the evaporated water when calculating the cost of water. Typical bleed rates range between 10 and 50% of the evaporation rate. Foggers use high-purity water produced by reverse osmosis or demineralization; this water produces a waste stream of 10 to 30% that may need to be included in the water usage calculation.

Water-cooled chillers use water at the cooling tower. Usage is a function of the amount of cooling, and is about 0.0004 to 0.0005 L/s per kilowatt of chiller capacity.

Bleedoff and drift from the cooling tower should be added to the evaporated water when refining the calculation for water cost. The bleed depends on water treatment and quality, and drift is a function of the tower's water recirculation rate. For more information, refer to Chapter 40.

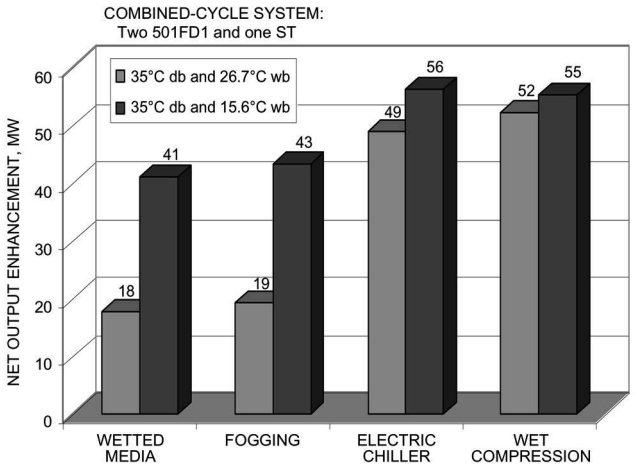

Fig. 11 Examples of Effect of CTIC Technology and Ambient Condition on Capacity Enhancement Potential
(TICA 2008)

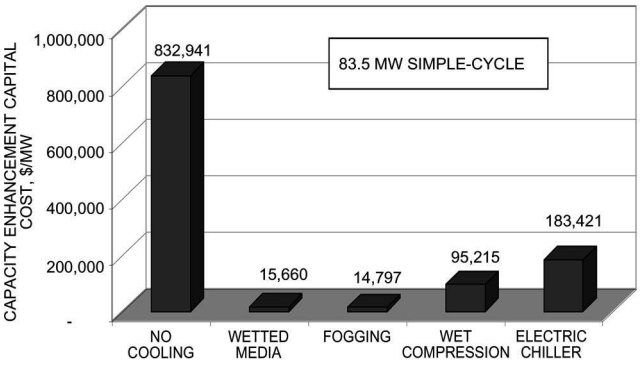

Fig. 12 Example of Effects of CTIC Technology and Ambient Condition on Unitized Capital Cost of Capacity Enhancement
(TICA 2008)

In applications using cooling coils or direct heat exchangers to cool the turbine inlet air stream, water may be produced by condensing (if ambient air is cooled below its dew point) and capturing moisture contained in the inlet air. This water can then be used in other locations of the power plant.

CTIC Cost. There are many variables in the cost, including turbine capacity, location, local labor rates, applicable local codes, and customer specifications.

Total installed cost of the CTIC system increases (although the cost per unit of capacity decreases) with increases in CT output and airflow rate capacities, because an increase in CT capacity increases the face area of the media for an evaporative cooler, and increases capacity and the heat exchange coil for the chiller system. For inlet fogging systems, increased airflow means an increase in pumping capacity and in the number of nozzles, pumps and stages. For the same reason, fogging system cost also increases proportionately with increasing differences between the wet- and dry-bulb temperatures. This can be equated to the enthalpy difference between air entering and leaving the coil. When sizing the chiller system, calculations should be based on the actual airflow of cooled air.

The cost of chiller systems depends heavily on the cooling load for the design day, and on whether (and in what configuration) TES is integrated with the CTIC chiller system.

Figures 11 and 12 show examples of the effects of CTIC and ambient conditions on capacity enhancement potential and the unitized capital cost of capacity enhancement.

Operation and Maintenance (O&M) Cost. O&M cost must also be considered, and varies considerably with the type of CTIC technology used. For an overview of O&M costs in general, see Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

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CHAPTER 9

APPLIED HEAT PUMP AND HEAT RECOVERY SYSTEMS

TERMINOLOGY 9.1
APPLIED HEAT PUMP SYSTEMS 9.1
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1. TERMINOLOGY

BALANCED heat recovery. Occurs when internal heat gain equals recovered heat and no external heat is introduced to the conditioned space. Maintaining balance may require raising the temperature of recovered heat. Many, if not most, systems do not have balanced heat recovery over time (e.g., during unoccupied periods or extreme cold) and require supplemental heat to overcome heat losses.

Break-even temperature. The outdoor temperature at which total heat losses from conditioned spaces equal internally generated heat gains.

Changeover temperature. The outdoor temperature the designer selects as the point of changeover from cooling to heating by the HVAC system.

Coefficient of performance (COP). The ratio of beneficial heat transferred at the heating and/or cooling heat exchangers of a heat pump to the energy used to power the heat pump. If both heating and cooling heat transfer are beneficial, both can be considered, though this is usually denoted as a *combined* COP.

Break-even COP. The COP at which the cost per kilojoule for a heat recovery heat pump system equals the cost per kilojoule of the system it is replacing.

External heat. Heat generated from sources outside the conditioned area. This heat from gas, oil, steam, electricity, or solar sources supplements internal heat and internal process heat sources. Recovered internal heat can reduce the demand for external heat.

Internal heat. Total passive heat generated within the conditioned space. It includes heat generated by lighting, computers, business machines, occupants, and mechanical and electrical equipment such as fans, pumps, compressors, and transformers.

Internal process heat. Heat from industrial activities and sources such as wastewater, boiler flue gas, coolants, exhaust air, and some waste materials. This heat is normally wasted unless equipment is included to extract it for further use.

Pinch technology. An energy analysis tool that uses vector analysis to evaluate all heating and cooling utilities in a process. Composite curves created by adding the vectors allow identification of a "pinch" point, which is the best thermal location for a heat pump.

Recovered (or reclaimed) heat. Comes from internal heat sources. It is used for space heating, domestic or service water heating, air reheat in air conditioning, process heating in industrial applications, or other similar purposes. Recovered heat may be stored for later use.

Stored heat. Heat from external or recovered heat sources that is held in reserve for later use.

System coefficient of performance. Ratio of heat recovery system output to entire system energy input, including compressor, pumps, etc.

Usable temperature. Temperature or range of temperatures at which heat energy can be absorbed, rejected, or stored for use within the system.

Useful thermal energy. Thermal energy (e.g., direct heat, steam, hot water) used in place of fuel or electricity for heating, cooling, humidity control, process use, etc. (U.S. GPO 2010).

Waste heat. Heat rejected from the building (or process) because its temperature is too low for economical recovery or direct use.

2. APPLIED HEAT PUMP SYSTEMS

A heat pump extracts heat from a source and transfers it to a sink at a higher temperature. According to this definition, all pieces of refrigeration equipment, including air conditioners and chillers with refrigeration cycles, are heat pumps. In engineering, however, the term **heat pump** is generally reserved for equipment that heats for beneficial purposes, rather than that which removes heat for cooling only. Dual-mode heat pumps alternately provide heating or cooling. Heat reclaim heat pumps provide heating only, or simultaneous heating and cooling. An applied heat pump requires competent field engineering for the specific application, in contrast to the use of a manufacturer-designed unitary product. Applied heat pumps include built-up heat pumps (field- or custom-assembled from components) and industrial process heat pumps. Most modern heat pumps use a vapor compression (modified Rankine) cycle or absorption cycle. Any of the other refrigeration cycles discussed in Chapter 2 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* are also suitable. Although most heat pump compressors are powered by electric motors, limited use is also made of engine and turbine drives. Applied heat pumps are most commonly used for heating and cooling buildings, but they are gaining popularity for efficient domestic and service water heating, pool heating, and industrial process heating.

Applied heat pumps with capacities from 7 kW to 44 MW operate in many facilities. Some machines are capable of output water temperatures up to 105°C and steam pressures up to 400 kPa (gage).

Compressors in large systems vary from one or more reciprocating or screw types to staged centrifugal types. A single or central system is often used, but in some instances, multiple heat pump systems are used to facilitate zoning. Heat sources include the ground, well water, surface water, gray water, solar energy, the air, and internal building heat. Compression can be single-stage or multistage. Frequently, heating and cooling are supplied simultaneously to separate zones.

Decentralized systems with water-loop heat pumps are common, using multiple water-source heat pumps connected to a common circulating water loop. They can also include ground coupling, heat

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.8, Geothermal Heat Pump and Energy Recovery Applications.

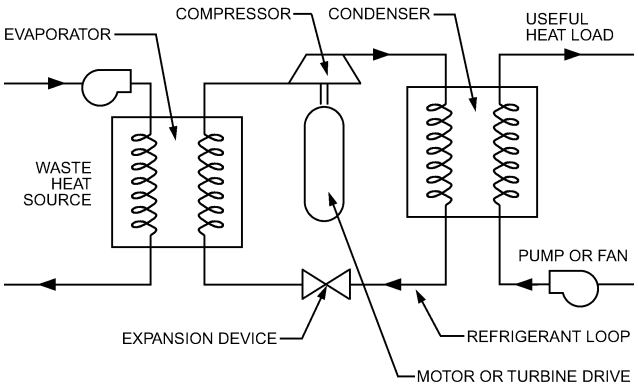


Fig. 1 Closed Vapor Compression Cycle

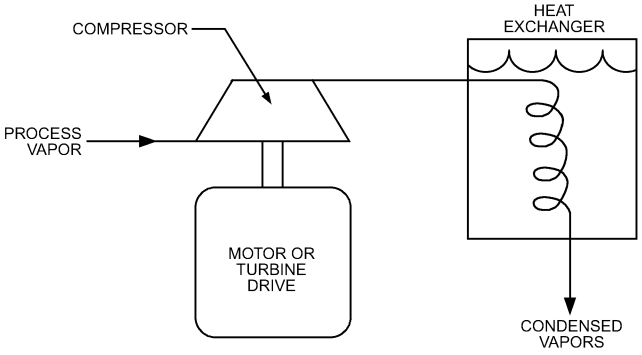


Fig. 2 Mechanical Vapor Recompression Cycle with Heat Exchanger

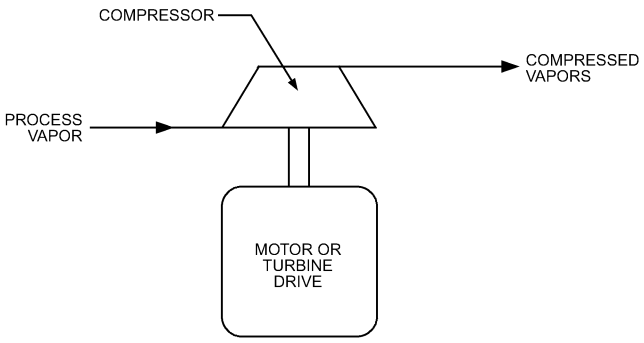


Fig. 3 Open Vapor Recompression Cycle

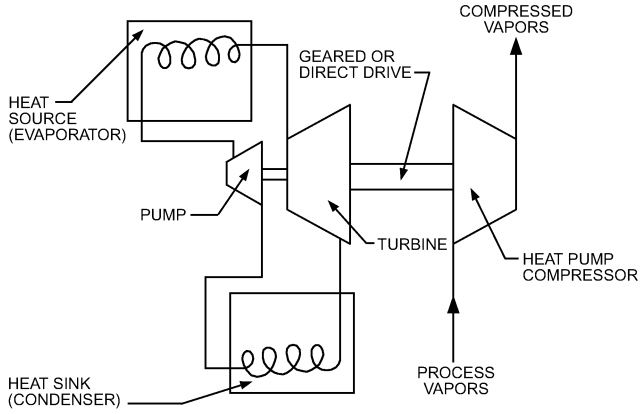


Fig. 4 Heat-Driven Rankine Cycle

rejectors (cooling towers and dry coolers), supplementary heaters (boilers and steam heat exchangers), loop reclaim heat pumps, solar collection devices, and thermal storage. The initial cost is relatively low, and building reconfiguration and individual space temperature control are easy.

Community and district heating and cooling systems can be based on both centralized and distributed heat pump systems.

2.1 HEAT PUMP CYCLES

Several types of applied heat pumps (both open- and closed-cycle) are available; some reverse their cycles to deliver both heating and cooling in HVAC systems, and others are for heating only in HVAC and industrial process applications. The following are the four basic types of heat pump cycles:

- **Closed vapor compression cycle** (Figure 1). This is the most common type in both HVAC and industrial processes. It uses a conventional, separate refrigeration cycle that may be single-stage, compound, multistage, or cascade.
- **Mechanical vapor recompression (MVR) cycle with heat exchanger** (Figure 2). Process vapor is compressed to a temperature and pressure sufficient for reuse directly in a process. Energy consumption is minimal, because temperatures are optimum for the process. Typical applications include evaporators (concentrators) and distillation columns.
- **Open vapor recompression cycle** (Figure 3). A typical application is in an industrial plant with a series of steam pressure levels and an excess of steam at a lower-than-desired pressure. Heat is pumped to a higher pressure by compressing the lower-pressure steam.
- **Heat-driven Rankine cycle** (Figure 4). This cycle is useful where large quantities of heat are wasted and energy costs are high. The heat pump portion of the cycle may be either open or closed, but the Rankine cycle is usually closed.

2.2 HEAT SOURCES AND SINKS

Table 1 shows the principal media used as heat sources and sinks. Selecting a heat source and sink for an application is primarily influenced by geographic location, climate, initial cost, availability, and type of structure. Table 1 presents various factors to be considered for each medium.

Air

Outdoor air is a universal heat source and sink medium for heat pumps and is widely used in residential and light commercial systems. Extended-surface, forced-convection heat transfer coils transfer heat between the air and refrigerant. Typically, the surface area of outdoor coils is 50 to 100% larger than that of indoor coils. The volume of outdoor air handled is also greater than the volume of indoor air handled by about the same percentage. During heating, the temperature of the evaporating refrigerant is generally 6 to 11 K less than the outdoor air temperature. Air heating and cooling coil performance is discussed in more detail in Chapters 23 and 27.

When selecting or designing an air-source heat pump, two factors in particular must be considered: (1) the local outdoor air temperature and (2) frost formation.

As the outdoor temperature decreases, the heating capacity of an air-source heat pump decreases. This makes equipment selection for a given outdoor heating design temperature more critical for an air-source heat pump than for a fuel-fired system. Equipment must be

Table 1 Heat Pump Sources and Sinks

Medium	Examples	Suitability: Heat Source	Suitability: Heat Sink	Availability: Location Relative to Need	Availability: Coincidence with Need	Cost: Installed	Cost: Operation and Maintenance	Temperature: Level	Temperature: Variation	Common Practice: Use	Common Practice: Limitations
AIR											
Outdoor	Ambient air	Good, but efficiency and capacity in heating mode decrease with decreasing outdoor air temperature	Good, but efficiency and capacity in cooling mode decrease with increasing outdoor air temperature	Universal	Continuous	Low	Moderate	Variable	Generally extreme	Most common, many standard products	Defrosting and supplemental heat usually required
Exhaust	Building ventilation	Excellent	Fair	Excellent if planned for in building design	Excellent	Low to moderate	Low unless exhaust is laden with dirt or grease	Excellent	Very low	Excellent as energy-conservation measure	Insufficient for typical loads
WATER											
Well*	Ground-water well may also provide potable water source	Excellent	Excellent	Poor to excellent; practical depth varies by location	Continuous	Low if existing well used or shallow wells suitable; can be high otherwise	Low, but periodic maintenance required	Generally excellent; varies by location	Extremely stable	Common	Water disposal and required permits may limit; may require double-wall exchangers; may foul or scale
Surface	Lakes, rivers, oceans	Excellent for large water bodies or high flow rates	Excellent for large water bodies or high flow rates	Limited; depends on proximity	Usually continuous	Depends on proximity and water quality	Depends on proximity and water quality	Usually satisfactory	Depends on source	Available, particularly for fresh water	Often regulated or prohibited; may clog, foul, or scale
Tap (city)	Municipal water supply	Excellent	Excellent	Excellent	Continuous	Low	Low energy cost, but water use and disposal may be costly	Excellent	Usually very low	Use is decreasing because of regulations	Use or disposal may be regulated or prohibited; may corrode or scale
Condens-ing	Cooling towers, re-frigeration systems	Excellent	Poor to good	Varies	Varies with cooling loads	Usually low	Moderate	Favorable as heat source	Depends on source	Available	Suitable only if heating need is coincident with heat rejection
Closed loops	Building water-loop heat pump systems	Good; loop may need supplemental heat	Favorable; may need loop heat rejection	Excellent if designed as such	As needed	Low	Low to moderate	As designed	As designed	Very common	Most suitable for medium or large buildings
Waste	Raw or treated sewage, gray water	Fair to excellent	Fair; varies with source	Varies	Varies; may be adequate	Depends on proximity; high for raw sewage	Varies; may be high for raw sewage	Excellent	Usually low	Uncommon; practical only in large systems	Usually regulated; may clog, foul, scale, or corrode
GROUND*											
Ground-coupled	Buried or submerged fluid loops	Good if ground is moist; other-wise poor	Fair to good if ground is moist; other-wise poor	Depends on soil suitability	Continuous	High to moderate	Low	Usually good	Low, particularly for vertical systems	Rapidly increasing	High initial costs for ground loop
Direct-expan-sion	Refrig-erant circulated in ground coil	Varies with soil conditions	Varies with soil conditions	Varies with soil conditions	Continuous	High	High	Varies by design	Generally low	Extremely limited	Leak repair very expensive; requires large refrigerant quantities
SOLAR ENERGY											
Direct or heated water	Solar collectors and panels	Fair	Poor; usually un-acceptable	Universal	Highly intermittent; night use requires storage	Extremely high	Moderate to high	Varies	Extreme	Very limited	Supplemental source or storage required
INDUSTRIAL PROCESS											
Process heat or exhaust	Distillation, molding, refining, washing, drying	Fair to excellent	Varies; often impractical	Varies	Varies	Varies	Generally low	Varies	Varies	Varies	May be costly unless heat need is near rejected source

*Groundwater-source heat pumps are also considered ground-source heat pump systems.

sized for as low a balance point as is practical for heating without having excessive and unnecessary cooling capacity during the summer. A procedure for finding this balance point, which is defined as the outdoor temperature at which heat pump capacity matches heating requirements, is given in Chapter 49.

When the surface temperature of an outdoor air coil is 0°C or less, with a corresponding outdoor air dry-bulb temperature 2 to 5.5 K higher, frost may form on the coil surface. If allowed to accumulate, frost inhibits heat transfer; therefore, the outdoor coil must be defrosted periodically. The number of defrosting operations is influenced by the climate, air-coil design, and the hours of operation. Experience shows that, generally, little defrosting is required when outdoor air conditions are below −8°C and 60% rh. This can be confirmed by psychrometric analysis using the principles given in Chapter 23. However, under very humid conditions, when small suspended water droplets are present in the air, the rate of frost deposit may be about three times as great as predicted from psychrometric theory and the heat pump may require defrosting after as little as 20 min of operation. The loss of available heating capacity caused by frosting should be considered when sizing an air-source heat pump.

Following commercial refrigeration practice, early designs of air-source heat pumps had relatively wide fin spacing of 5 to 6 mm, based on the theory that this would minimize defrosting frequency. However, experience has shown that effective hot-gas defrosting allows much closer fin spacing and reduces the system's size and bulk. In current practice, fin spacings of 1.3 to 2.5 mm are widely used.

In many institutional and commercial buildings, some air must be continuously exhausted year-round. This exhaust air can be used as a heat source, although supplemental heat is generally necessary.

High humidity caused by indoor swimming pools causes condensation on ceiling structural members, walls, windows, and floors and causes discomfort to spectators. Traditionally, outdoor air and dehumidification coils with reheat from a boiler that also heats the pool water are used. This is ideal for air-to-air and air-to-water heat pumps because energy costs can be reduced. Suitable materials must be chosen so that heat pump components are resistant to corrosion from pool treatment chemicals and high humidity.

Water

Water can be a satisfactory heat source, subject to the considerations listed in Table 1. City water is seldom used because of cost and municipal restrictions. Groundwater (well water) is particularly attractive as a heat source because of its relatively high and nearly constant temperature. Water temperature depends on source depth and climate, but, in the United States, generally ranges from 5°C in northern areas to 21°C in southern areas. Frequently, sufficient water is available from wells (water can be reinjected into the aquifer). This use is nonconsumptive and, with proper design, only the water temperature changes. Water quality should be analyzed, and the possibility of scale formation and corrosion should be considered. In some instances, it may be necessary to separate the well fluid from the equipment with an additional heat exchanger. Special consideration must also be given to filtering and settling ponds for specific fluids. Other considerations are the costs of drilling, piping, pumping, and a means for disposal of used water. Information on well water availability, temperature, and chemical and physical analysis is available from U.S. Geological Survey offices in many major cities. For further information on water quality, groundwater heat pumps, or surface water heat pumps, see Chapter 35 in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, or Kavanaugh and Rafferty (2014).

Heat exchangers may also be submerged in open ponds, lakes, or streams. When surface or stream water is used as a source, the temperature drop across the evaporator in winter may need to be limited to prevent freeze-up.

In industrial applications, waste process water (e.g., spent warm water in laundries, plant effluent, warm condenser water) may be a heat source for heat pump operation.

Sewage, which often has temperatures higher than that of surface or groundwater, may be an acceptable heat source. Secondary effluent (treated sewage) is usually preferred, but untreated sewage may be used successfully with proper heat exchanger design (Phetteplace and Ueda 1989).

Use of water during cooling follows the conventional practice for water-cooled condensers.

Water-to-refrigerant heat exchangers are generally direct-expansion or flooded water coolers, usually shell-and-coil or shell-and-tube. Brazed-plate heat exchangers may also be used. In large applied heat pumps, the water is usually reversed instead of the refrigerant.

Ground

The ground is used extensively as a heat source and sink, with heat transfer through buried coils. Soil composition, which varies widely from wet clay to sandy soil, has a predominant effect on thermal properties and expected overall performance. The heat transfer process in soil depends on transient heat flow. Thermal diffusivity is a dominant factor and is difficult to determine without local soil data. Thermal diffusivity is the ratio of thermal conductivity to the product of density and specific heat. The soil's moisture content influences its thermal conductivity.

There are three primary types of ground-source heat pumps: (1) groundwater, which is discussed in the previous section; (2) direct-expansion, in which the ground-to-refrigerant heat exchanger is buried underground; and (3) ground-coupled (also called closed-loop ground-source), in which a secondary loop with a brine connects the ground-to-water and water-to-refrigerant heat exchangers (see Figure 5).

Ground loops can be placed either horizontally or vertically. A horizontal system consists of single or multiple serpentine heat exchanger pipes buried 1 to 2 m apart in a horizontal plane at a depth 1 to 2 m below grade. Pipes may be buried deeper, but excavation costs and temperature must be considered. Horizontal systems can also use coiled loops referred to as **slinky coils**. A vertical system uses a concentric tube or U-tube heat exchanger. Design of ground-coupled heat exchangers is covered in Chapter 35 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* and Kavanaugh and Rafferty (2014).

Solar Energy

Solar energy may be used either as the primary heat source or in combination with other sources. Air, surface water, shallow groundwater, and shallow ground-source systems all use solar energy indirectly. The principal advantage of using solar energy directly is that, when available, it provides heat at a higher temperature than the indirect sources, increasing the heating coefficient of performance. Compared to solar heating without a heat pump, the collector efficiency and capacity are increased because a lower collector temperature is required.

The **direct** system places refrigerant evaporator tubes in a solar collector, usually a flat-plate type. A collector without glass cover plates can also extract heat from the outdoor air. The same surface may then serve as a condenser using outdoor air as a heat sink for cooling.

An **indirect** system circulates either water or air through the solar collector. When air is used, the collector may be controlled in such a way that (1) the collector can serve as an outdoor air preheater, (2) the outdoor air loop can be closed so that all source heat is derived from the sun, or (3) the collector can be disconnected from the outdoor air serving as the source or sink.

2.3 TYPES OF HEAT PUMPS

Heat pumps are classified by (1) heat source and sink, (2) heating and cooling distribution fluid, (3) thermodynamic cycle, (4) building structure, (5) size and configuration, and (6) limitation of the source and sink. Figure 5 shows the more common types of closed vapor-compression cycle heat pumps for heating and cooling service.

Air-to-Air Heat Pumps. This type of heat pump is the most common and is particularly suitable for factory-built unitary heat pumps. It is widely used in residential and commercial applications (see Chapter 48). The first diagram in Figure 5 is a typical refrigeration circuit.

In air-to-air heat pump systems, air circuits can be interchanged by motor-driven or manually operated dampers to obtain either heated or cooled air for the conditioned space. In this system, one heat exchanger coil is always the evaporator, and the other is always the condenser. Conditioned air passes over the evaporator during the cooling cycle, and outdoor air passes over the condenser. Damper positioning causes the change from cooling to heating.

Water-to-Air Heat Pumps. These heat pumps rely on water as the heat source and sink, and use air to transmit heat to or from the conditioned space. (See the second diagram in Figure 5.) They include the following:

- ***Groundwater heat pumps***, which use groundwater from wells as a heat source and/or sink. They can either circulate source water directly to the heat pump or use an intermediate fluid in a closed loop, similar to the ground-coupled heat pump.
- ***Surface water heat pumps***, which use surface water from a lake, pond, or stream as a heat source or sink. As with ground-coupled and groundwater heat pumps, these systems can either circulate source water directly to the heat pump or use an intermediate fluid in a closed loop.
- ***Internal-source heat pumps***, which use the high internal cooling load generated in modern buildings either directly or with storage. These include water-loop heat pumps.
- ***Solar-assisted heat pumps***, which rely on low-temperature solar energy as the heat source. Solar heat pumps may resemble water-to-air, or other types, depending on the form of solar heat collector and the type of heating and cooling distribution system.
- ***Wastewater-source heat pumps***, which use sanitary waste heat or laundry waste heat as a heat source. Waste fluid can be introduced directly into the heat pump evaporator after waste filtration, or it can be taken from a storage tank, depending on the application. An intermediate loop may also be used for heat transfer between the evaporator and the waste heat source.

Water-to-Water Heat Pumps. These heat pumps use water as the heat source and sink for cooling and heating. Heating/cooling changeover can be done in the refrigerant circuit, but it is often more convenient to perform the switching in the water circuits, as shown in the third diagram of Figure 5. Although the diagram shows direct admittance of the water source to the evaporator, in some cases, it may be necessary to apply the water source indirectly through a heat exchanger (or double-wall evaporator) to avoid contaminating the closed chilled-water system, which is normally treated. Another method uses a closed-circuit condenser water system.

Ground-Coupled Heat Pumps. These use the ground as a heat source and sink. A heat pump may have a refrigerant-to-water heat exchanger or may be direct expansion (DX). Both types are shown in Figure 5. In systems with refrigerant-to-water heat exchangers, a water or antifreeze solution is pumped through horizontal, vertical, or coiled pipes embedded in the ground. Direct-expansion ground-coupled heat pumps use refrigerant in direct-expansion, flooded, or recirculation evaporator circuits for the ground pipe coils.

Soil type, moisture content, composition, density, and uniformity close to the surrounding field areas affect the success of this method of heat exchange. With some piping materials, the material of construction for the pipe and the corrosiveness of the local soil and underground water may affect the heat transfer and service life. In a variation of this cycle, all or part of the heat from the evaporator plus the heat of compression are transferred to a water-cooled condenser. This condenser heat is then available for uses such as heating air or domestic hot water.

A **hybrid ground-coupled heat pump** is a variation that uses a cooling tower or air-cooled condenser to reduce the total annual heat rejection to the ground coupling.

Additional heat pump types include the following:

Air-to-Water Heat Pumps Without Changeover. These heat pumps use both sensible and latent heat in air from either natural sources (e.g., tropical climates) or from indoor air that needs to be dehumidified and cooled for comfort. They are commonly called **heat pump water heaters**. Heat from the heat pump is used to heat domestic and/or service water. Chapter 48 of this volume and Chapter 51 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* have more detail on the equipment.

Refrigerant-to-Water Heat Pumps. These condense a refrigerant by the cascade principle. Cascading pumps the heat to a higher temperature, where it is rejected to water or another liquid. This type of heat pump can also serve as a condensing unit to cool almost any fluid or process. More than one heat source can be used to offset those times when insufficient heat is available from the primary source.

2.4 HEAT PUMP COMPONENTS

For the most part, the components and practices associated with heat pumps evolved from work with low-temperature refrigeration. This section outlines the major components and discusses characteristics or special considerations that apply to heat pumps in combined room heating and air-conditioning applications or in higher temperature industrial applications.

Compressors

The principal types of compressors used in applied heat pump systems are briefly described in this section. For more details on these compressor types and others, refer to Chapter 38.

- **Centrifugal compressors.** Most centrifugal applications in heat pumps have been limited to large water-to-water or refrigerant-to-water heat pump systems, heat transfer systems, storage systems, and hydronically cascaded systems. With these applications, the centrifugal compressor allows heat pump use in industrial plants, as well as in large multistory buildings; many installations have double-bundle condensers. The transfer cycles allow low pressure ratios, and many single- and two-stage units with various refrigerants are operational with high coefficients of performance (COPs). Centrifugal compressor characteristics do not usually meet the needs of air-source heat pumps. High pressure ratios, or high lifts, associated with low gas volume at low load conditions cause the centrifugal compressor to surge.
- **Screw compressors.** Screw compressors offer high pressure ratios at low to high capacities. Capacity control is usually provided by variable porting or sliding vanes. Generally, large oil separators are required, because many compressors use oil injection. Screw compressors are less susceptible to damage from liquid spillover and have fewer parts than do reciprocating compressors. They also simplify capacity modulation.
- **Rotary vane compressors.** These compressors can be used for the low stage of a multistage plant; they have a high capacity but are generally limited to lower pressure ratios. They also have limited means for capacity reduction.

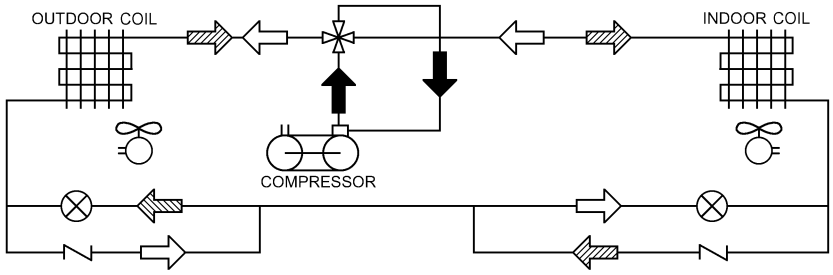
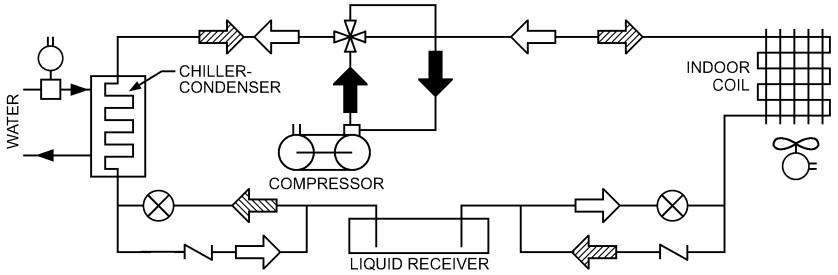
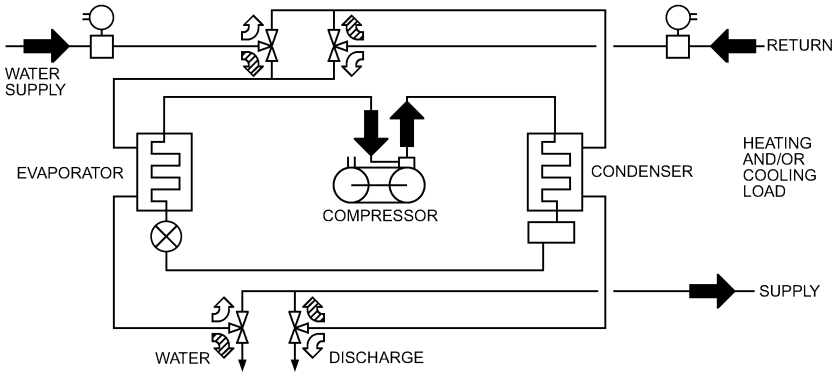
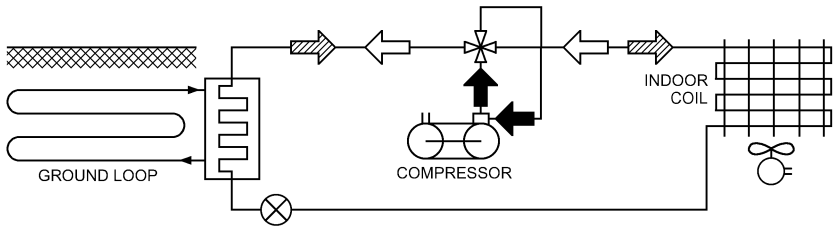
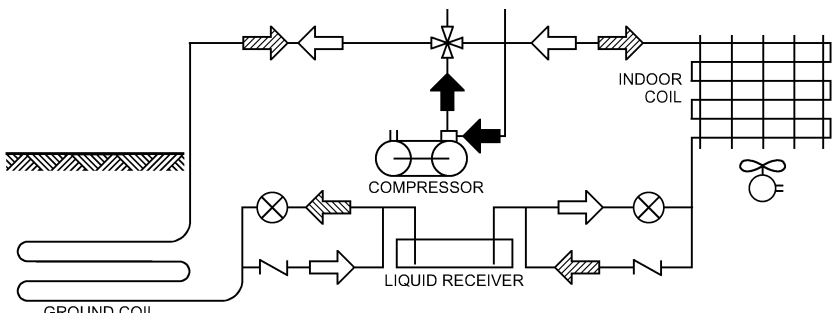
Heat Source and Sink	Distribution Fluid	Thermal Cycle	Diagram (Heating / Cooling / Heating and Cooling)
Air	Air	Refrigerant changeover	
Water	Air	Refrigerant changeover	
Water	Water	Water changeover	
Ground-coupled (or Closed-loop ground-source)	Air	Refrigerant changeover	
Ground-source, Direct-expansion	Air	Refrigerant changeover	

Fig. 5 Heat Pump Types

- **Reciprocating compressors.** These compressors are the most common for 1.8 to 350 kW systems.
- **Scroll compressors.** These are a type of orbital motion positive-displacement compressor. Their use in heat pump systems is increasing. Their capacity can be controlled by varying the drive speed or the compressor displacement. Scroll compressors have low noise and vibration levels.

Compressor Selection. A compressor used for comfort cooling usually has a medium clearance volume ratio (the ratio of gas volume remaining in the cylinder after compression to the total swept volume). For an air-source heat pump, a compressor with a smaller clearance volume ratio is more suitable for low-temperature operation and provides greater refrigerating capacity at lower evaporator temperatures. However, this compressor requires somewhat more power under maximum cooling load than one with medium clearance.

More total heat capacity can be obtained at low outdoor temperatures by deliberately oversizing the compressor. This allows some capacity reduction for operation at higher outdoor temperatures by multispeed or variable-speed drives, cylinder cutouts, or other methods. The disadvantage is that the greater number of operating hours that occur at the higher suction temperatures must be served with the compressor unloaded, which generally lowers efficiency and raises annual operating cost. The additional initial cost of the oversized compressor must be economically justified by the gain in heating capacity.

One method proposed for increasing heating output at low temperatures uses **staged compression**. For example, one compressor may compress from –35°C saturated suction temperature (SST) to 5°C saturated discharge temperature (SDT), and a second compressor compresses the vapor from 5°C SST to 50°C SDT. In this arrangement, the two compressors may be interconnected in parallel, with both pumping from about 7°C SST to 50°C SDT for cooling. Then, at some predetermined outdoor temperature on heating, they are reconnected in series and compress in two successive stages.

Figure 6 shows the performance of a pair of compressors for units of both medium and low clearance volume. At low suction temperatures, the reconnection in series adds some capacity. However, the motor for this case must be selected for the maximum loading conditions for summer operation, even though the low-stage compressor has a greatly reduced power requirement under the heating condition.

Compressor Floodback Protection. A suction line separator, similar to that shown in Figure 7, combined with a liquid-gas heat exchanger can be used to minimize migration and harmful liquid floodback to the compressor. The solenoid valve should be controlled to open when the compressor is operating, and the hand valve should then be adjusted to provide an acceptable bleed rate into the suction line.

Heat Transfer Components

Refrigerant-to-air and refrigerant-to-water heat exchangers are similar to heat exchangers used in air-conditioning refrigeration systems.

Defrosting Air-Source Coils. Frost accumulates rather heavily on outdoor-air-source coils when the outdoor air temperature is less than approximately 5°C, but lessens somewhat with the simultaneous decrease in outdoor temperature and moisture content. Most systems defrost by reversing the cycle.

Another method of defrosting is spraying heated water over an outdoor coil. The water can be heated by the refrigerant or by auxiliaries.

Draining Heat Source and Heat Sink Coils. Direct-expansion indoor and outdoor heat transfer surfaces serve as condensers and evaporators. Both surfaces, therefore, must have proper refrigerant distribution headers to serve as evaporators and have suitable liquid refrigerant drainage while serving as condensers.

Flooded systems use the normal float control to maintain the required liquid refrigerant level.

Liquid Subcooling Coils. A refrigerant subcooling coil can be added to the heat pump cycle (Figure 8) to preheat ventilation air during heating and, at the same time, to lower the liquid refrigerant temperature. Depending on the refrigerant circulation rate and quantity and temperature of ventilation air, heating capacity can be increased as much as 15 to 20%, as indicated in Figure 9.

Refrigeration Components

Refrigerant piping, receivers, expansion devices, and refrigeration accessories in heat pumps are usually the same as components found in other types of refrigeration and air-conditioning systems.

A **reversing valve** changes the system from cooling to heating mode. This changeover requires using a valve(s) in the refrigerant circuit, except where the change occurs in fluid circuits external to the refrigerant circuit. Reversing valves are usually pilot-operated

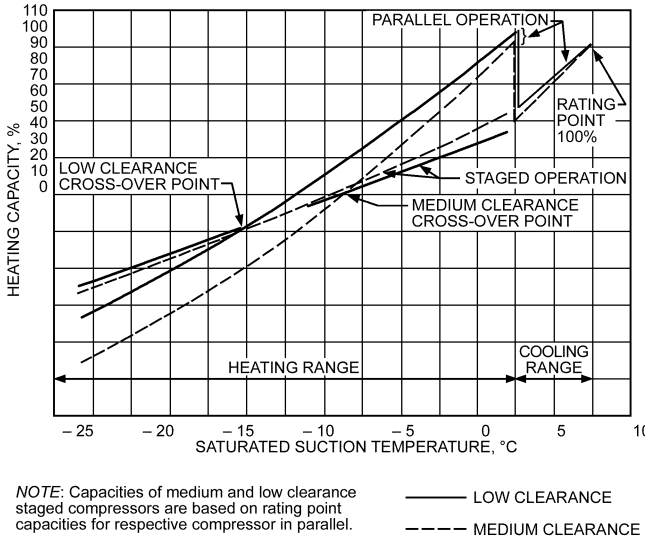


Fig. 6 Comparison of Parallel and Staged Operation for Air-Source Heat Pumps

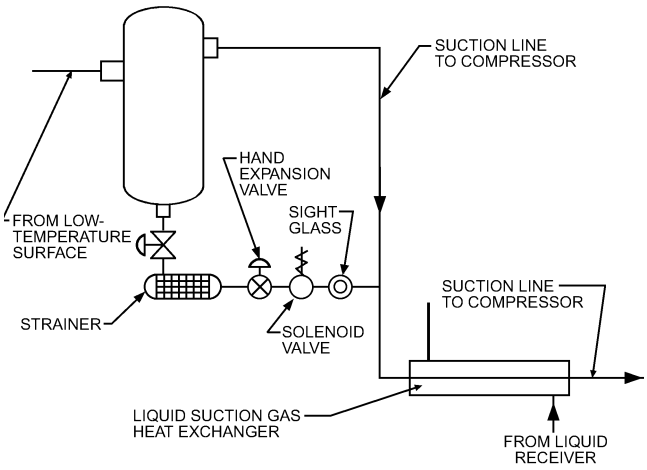


Fig. 7 Suction Line Separator for Protection Against Liquid Floodback

by solenoid valves, which admit compressor head and suction pressures to move the operating elements.

The **expansion device** for controlling the refrigerant flow is normally a **thermostatic expansion valve**, which is described in Chapter 11 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration.* The control bulb must be located carefully. If the circuit is arranged so that the refrigerant line on which the control bulb is placed can become the compressor discharge line, the resulting pressure developed in the valve power element may be excessive, requiring a special control charge or pressure-limiting element. When a thermostatic expansion valve is applied to an outdoor air coil, a special cross-charge to limit the superheat at low temperatures allows better use of the coil. In its temperature-sensing element, a cross-charged thermostatic expansion valve uses a fluid, or mixture of fluids, that is different from the refrigerant. An **electronic expansion valve** improves control of refrigerant flow.

A **capillary tube** (used as a metering device for an air-source heat pump that operates over a wide range of evaporating temperatures) may pass refrigerant at an excessive rate at low back pressures, causing liquid floodback to the compressor. Suction line accumulators or charge-control devices are sometimes added to minimize this effect. Suction line accumulators may also prevent liquid refrigerant that has migrated to the evaporator from entering the compressor on start-up.

When separate metering devices are used for the two heat exchangers, a **check valve** allows refrigerant to bypass the metering device of the heat exchanger serving as the condenser.

A **refrigerant receiver**, which is commonly used to store liquid refrigerant, is particularly useful in a heat pump to take care of the unequal refrigerant requirements of heating and cooling. The receiver is usually omitted on heat pumps used for heating only.

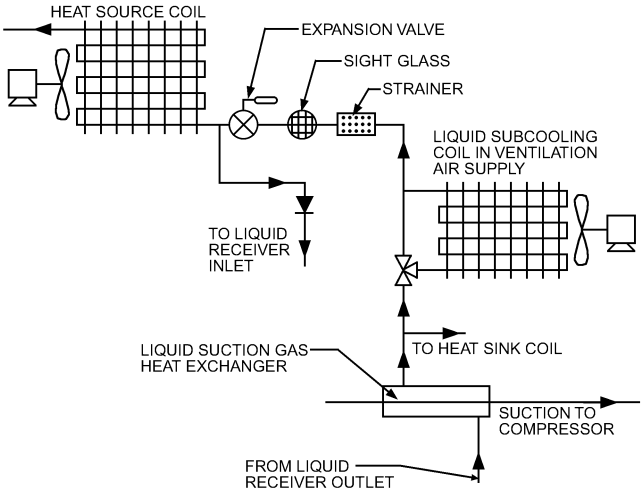


Fig. 8 Liquid Subcooling Coil in Ventilation Air Supply to Increase Heating Effect and Heating COP

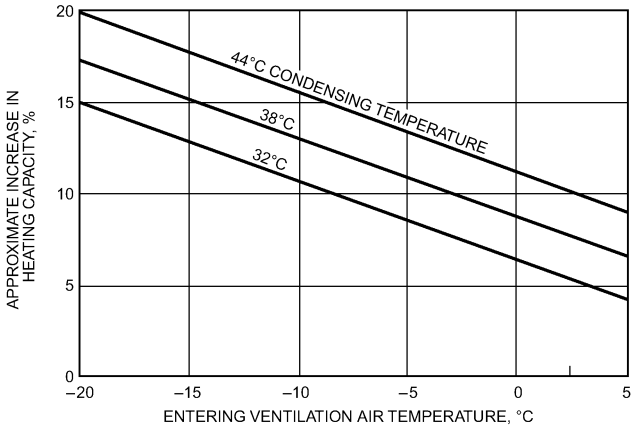


Fig. 9 Typical Increase in Heating Capacity Resulting from Using Liquid Subcooling Coil

Controls

Defrost Control. A variety of defrosting control schemes can sense the need for defrosting air-source heat pumps and initiate (and terminate) the defrost cycle. The cycle is usually initiated by demand rather than a timer, though termination may be timer-controlled.

Defrost can also be terminated by either a control sensing the coil pressure or a thermostat that measures the temperature of liquid refrigerant in the outdoor coil. Completion of defrosting is ensured when the temperature (or corresponding saturation pressure) of the liquid leaving the outdoor coil rises to about 21°C.

A widely used means of starting the defrost cycle on demand is a pressure control that reacts to the air pressure drop across the coil. When frost accumulates, airflow is reduced and the increased pressure drop across the coil initiates the defrost cycle. This method is applicable only in a clean outdoor environment where fouling of the air side of the outdoor coil is not expected.

Another method for sensing frost formation and initiating defrosting on demand involves a temperature differential control and two temperature-sensing elements. One element is responsive to outdoor air temperature and the other to the temperature of the refrigerant in the coil. As frost accumulates, the temperature differential between the outdoor air and the refrigerant increases, initiating defrost. The system is restored to operation when the refrigerant temperature in the coil reaches a specified temperature, indicating that defrosting has been completed. When outdoor air temperature decreases, the differential between outdoor air temperature and refrigerant temperature decreases because of reduced heat pump capacity. Thus, unless compensation is provided, the defrost cycle is not initiated until a greater amount of frost has built up.

The following controls may be used to change from heating to cooling:

- **Conditioned space thermostats** on residences and small commercial applications.
- **Outdoor air thermostats** (with provision for manual overriding for variable solar and internal load conditions) on larger installations, where it may be difficult to find a location in the conditioned space that is representative of the total building.
- **Manual changeover** using a heat/off/cool position on the indoor thermostat. A single thermostat is used for each heat pump unit.
- **Sensing devices**, which respond to the greater load requirement, heating or cooling, are generally used on simultaneous heating and cooling systems.
- **Dedicated microcomputers** to automate changeover and perform all the other control functions needed, and to simultaneously monitor the performance of the system. This may be a stand-alone device, or it may be incorporated as part of a larger building automation system.

On the heat pump system, it is important that space thermostats are interlocked with ventilation dampers so that both operate on the same cycle. During the heating cycle, the outdoor air damper should be positioned for the minimum required ventilation air, with the space thermostat calling for increased ventilation air only if the conditioned space becomes too warm. Fan and/or pump interlocks are generally provided to prevent the heat pump system from oper-

ating if the accessory equipment is not available. On commercial and industrial installations, some form of pressure control is required on the condenser when cooling at outdoor air temperatures below 15°C.

Supplemental Heating

Heating needs may exceed the heating capacity available from equipment selected for the cooling load, particularly if outdoor air is used as the heat source. When this occurs, supplemental heating or additional compressor capacity should be considered. The additional compressor capacity or the supplemental heat is generally used only in the severest winter weather and, consequently, has a low usage factor. Both possibilities must be evaluated to determine the most economical selection.

When supplemental heaters are used, the elements should always be located in the air or water circuit downstream from the heat pump condenser. This allows the system to operate at a lower condensing temperature, increasing heating capacity and improving the COP. Controls should sequence the heaters so that they are energized after all heat pump compressors are fully loaded. An outdoor thermostat is recommended to limit or prevent energizing heater elements during mild weather when they are not needed. Where 100% supplemental heat is provided for emergency operation, it may be desirable to keep one or more stages of the heaters locked out whenever the compressor is running. In this way, the cost of electrical service to the building is reduced by limiting the maximum coincidental demand.

A flow switch should be used to prevent operation of the heating elements and heat pump when there is no air or water flow.

2.5 INDUSTRIAL PROCESS HEAT PUMPS

Heat recovery in industry offers numerous opportunities for applied heat pumps. The two major classes of industrial heat pump systems are closed-cycle and open-cycle. Factory-packaged, closed-cycle machines have been built to heat fluids to 50°C and as high as 105°C. Skid-mounted open- and semi-open-cycle machines have been used to produce low-level saturated and superheated steam.

The original closed-cycle machines used in designs into the 1990s used old CFC refrigerants such as CFC-11, CFC-12, CFC-113, and CFC-114. However, the Montreal Protocol discontinued these refrigerants, and useful output temperatures of these systems dropped to the 50 to 54°C range. Manufacturers sometimes limited their offerings of closed-cycle systems because sales volumes were so low compared to chillers with the new refrigerants. However, with newer refrigerants such as R-134a, R-410A, and R-410B, output temperatures for closed-cycle machines have returned to the necessary industrial levels (70 to 82°C), and coupling new compressors with these refrigerants has increased efficiencies.

Industrial heat pumps are generally used for process heating rather than space heating. Each heat pump system must be designed for the particular application. Rather than being dictated by weather or design standards, the selection of size and output temperature for a system is often affected by economic restraints, environmental standards, or desired levels of product quality or output. This gives the designer more flexibility in equipment selection because the systems are frequently applied in conjunction with a more traditional process heating system such as steam.

ASHRAE research project RP-656 (Cane et al. 1994) gathered information on energy performance, economics of operation, operating difficulties, operator and management reactions, and design details for various **heat recovery heat pump** (HRHP) systems. The most common reason given for installing HRHP systems was reducing energy cost. Other reasons cited were

- Need to eliminate bacterial growth in storage tanks
- Need to increase ammonia refrigeration system capacity
- Reduction of makeup water use
- Need for flexibility in processing
- Year-round processing (drying) possible
- Superior drying quality compared with conventional forced-air kilns
- Process emissions eliminated without the need for costly pollution control equipment
- Recovery and reuse of product from process
- Reduced effluent into the environment

Economics associated with energy reductions were calculated for most of the test sites. Economic justifications for the other reasons for installation were difficult to estimate. Only half the survey sites reported actual payback periods. Half of these had simple paybacks of less than 5 years. These findings still apply today: the new heat pumps have restored the original machine capabilities, and often improved them.

The most frequently cited problem was widely fluctuating heat source or sink flow rates or temperatures. Considerable differences between design parameters and actual conditions were also mentioned frequently. In some cases, the difference resulted in oversizing, which caused poor response to load variation, nuisance shutdowns, and equipment failure. Other problems were significant process changes after installation and poor placement of the HRHP.

The number of projects that had overstated savings based on overstated run hours demonstrated the need for accurate prediction methods. Although the low hours of use in some cases resulted from first-year start-up and balancing issues, in most cases it was due to plant capacity reductions, process modifications, or other factors that were not understood during the design phase. It is recommended that water flows and temperatures be measured and then compared to actual process activities during the test period. These numbers can be used to predict future needs compared to projected process requirements. Adding surge and storage tanks also reduces this issue, because they allow for leveling of batch process variations.

Closed-Cycle Systems

Closed-cycle systems use a suitable working fluid, usually a refrigerant in a sealed system. They can use either absorption or vapor compression. Heat is transferred to and from the system through heat exchangers similar to refrigeration system heat exchangers. Closed-cycle heat pump systems are often classed with industrial refrigeration systems except that they operate at higher temperatures.

Heat exchangers used must comply with federal and local codes. For example, a double separation between potable water and refrigerant is usually required. However, some applications need local interpretation of potable versus service definitions, such as water used in food preparation (e.g., poultry scalders, equipment cleanup).

Heat exchangers must also be resistant to corrosion and fouling conditions of the source and sink fluids. The refrigerant and oil must be (1) compatible with component materials and (2) mutually compatible at the expected operating temperatures. In addition, the viscosity and foaming characteristics of the oil and refrigerant mixtures must be consistent with the lubrication requirements at the specific mechanical load imposed on the equipment. Proper oil return and heat transfer at the evaporators and condensers must also be considered.

The specific application of a closed-cycle heat pump frequently dictates the selection considerations. In this section, the different types of closed-cycle systems are reviewed, and factors important to the selection process are addressed.

Air-to-air heat pumps or **dehumidification heat pumps** (Figure 10) are most frequently used in industrial operations to dry or cure products. For example, dehumidification kilns are used to dry

lumber to improve its value. Compared to conventional steam kilns, the heat pump provides two major benefits: improved product quality and reduced percent degrade. With dehumidification, lumber can be dried at a lower temperature, which reduces warping, cracking, checking, and discoloration. The system must be selected according to the type of wood (i.e., hard or soft) and the required dry time. Dehumidification heat pumps can also be used to dry agricultural products; poultry, fish, and meat; textiles; and other products.

Air-to-water heat pumps or **heat pump water heaters** (Figure 11) are a special application of closed-cycle systems that are usually used to dehumidify indoor air where humidity is generated from some activity or process. Typical applications are indoor pools, large commercial kitchens, and industrial laundries. In many tropical climates, the ambient air can also be used to heat water economically where power systems are costly and local natural gas is scarce (e.g., on islands). In most of these applications, the air coil is usually wet and may require coated coils or special metallurgy. See Chapter 48 of this volume and Chapter 51 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information.

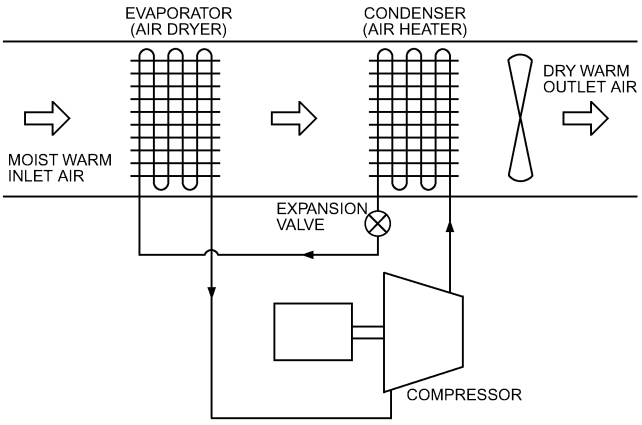


Fig. 10 Dehumidification Heat Pump

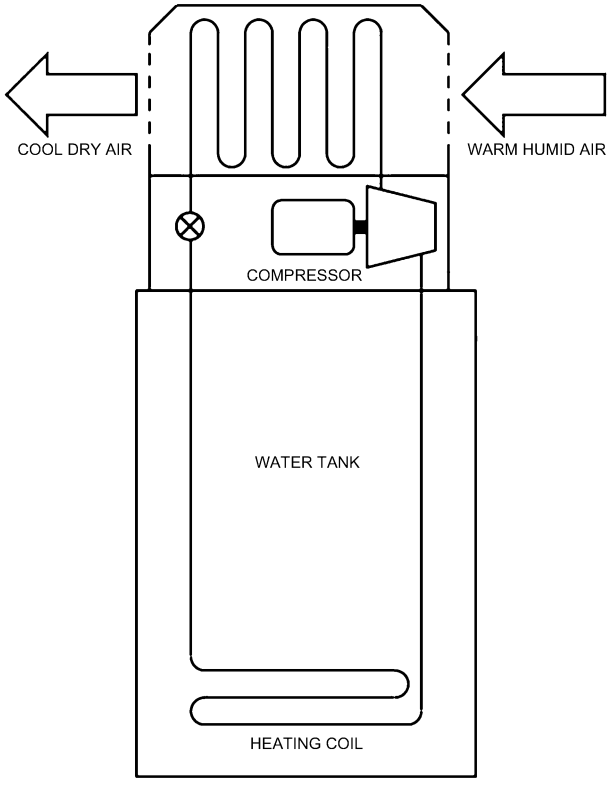


Fig. 11 Air-to-Water Heat Pump

Water-to-water heat pumps may have the most widespread application in industry. They can use cooling tower water, effluent streams, and even chilled-water makeup streams as heat sources. The output hot water can be used for product rinse tanks, equipment cleanup water systems, and product preheaters. The water-to-water heat pump system may be simple, such as that shown in Figure 12, which recovers heat from a process cooling tower to heat water for another process. Figure 12 also shows the integration of a heat exchanger for preheating the process water. Typically, the heat pump COP is in the range of 4 to 6, and the system COP reaches 8 to 15.

Water-to-water heat pump systems may also be complicated, such as the cascaded HRHP system (Figure 13) for a textile dyeing and finishing plant. Heat recovered from various process effluent streams is used to preheat makeup water for the processes. The effluent streams may contain materials, such as lint and yarn, and highly corrosive chemicals that may foul the heat exchanger; therefore, special materials and antifouling devices may be needed for the heat exchanger for a successful design.

Most food-processing plants, which use more water than a desuperheater or a combination desuperheater/condenser can provide, can use a water-to-water heat pump (Figure 14). A water-cooled condenser recovers both sensible and latent heat from the high-pressure refrigerant. Water heated in the condenser is split into two streams: one as a heat source for the water-to-water heat pump, the other to preheat themakeup, process, or cleanup water. Preheated water is blended with hot water from the storage tank to limit the temperature difference across the heat pump condenser to about 11 K, which is standard for many chiller applications. The heated water is then piped back to the storage tank, which is typically sized for 1.5 to 5 h of holding capacity. Because the refrigeration load may be insufficient to provide all the water heating required, existing water heaters (usually steam) provide additional heat and control for process water at the point of use.

Three major tasks must be addressed when adding heat recovery to existing plant refrigeration systems: (1) forcing the hot-gas refrigerant to flow to the desired heat exchanger, (2) scheduling the refrigeration processes to provide an adequate heat source over time while still meeting process requirements, and (3) integrating water-

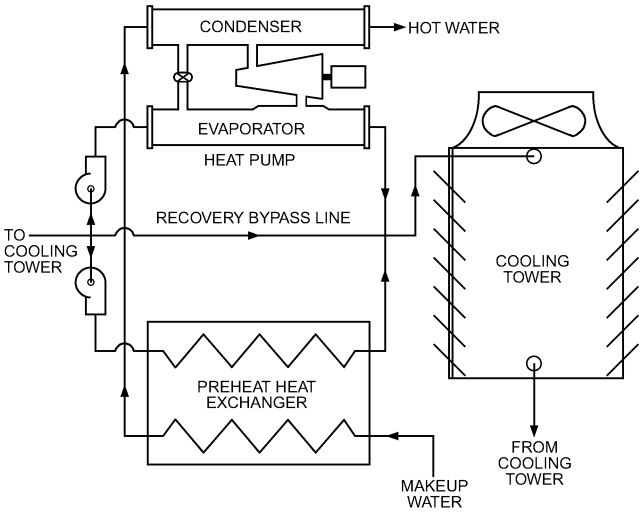


Fig. 12 Cooling Tower Heat Recovery Heat Pump

cooled condensers with evaporative condensers. The refrigerant direction can be controlled either by series piping of the two condenser systems or by three pressure-regulating valves (PRVs): one to the hot-gas defrost (lowest-pressure setting), one to the recovery system (medium-pressure setting), and one to the evaporative condensers (highest-pressure setting). PRVs offer good control but can be mechanically complicated. Series piping is simple but can cost more because of the pipe size required for all the hot gas to pass through the water-cooled condenser.

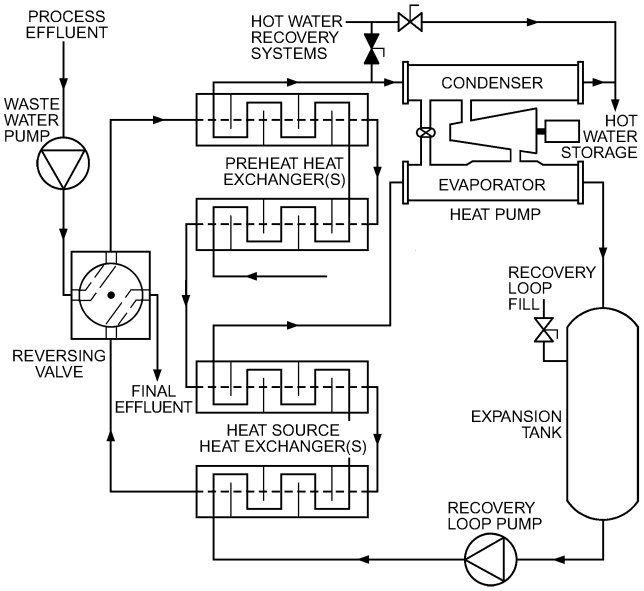


Fig. 13 Effluent Heat Recovery Heat Pump

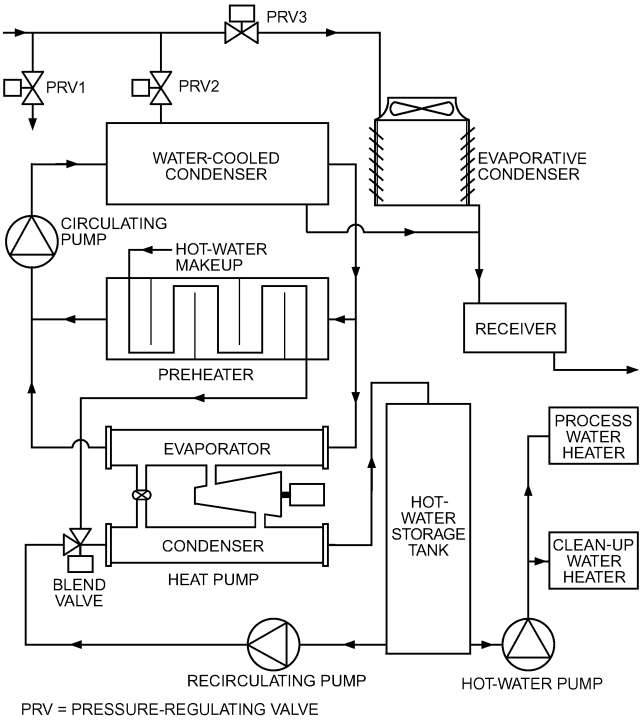


Fig. 14 Refrigeration Heat Recovery Heat Pump

Each refrigeration load should be reviewed for its required output and production requirements. For example, ice production can frequently be scheduled during cleanup periods, and blast freezing for the end of shifts.

In multisystem integration, as in expanded system integration, equalization lines, liquid lines, receivers, and so forth must be designed according to standard refrigeration practices.

Ammonia compressors in a condensing (Figure 15) or cascaded system sometimes can also be used where plant refrigerant gas is compressed further to generate the needed temperature. This option is strongly influenced by the plant refrigeration and compressor systems, because pressure requirements may require high-pressure compressors. Consult the ammonia compressor manufacturer if considering this option.

Process-fluid-to-process-fluid heat pumps can be applied to evaporation, concentration, crystallization, and distillation process fluids that contain chemicals that would destroy a steam compressor. A closed-cycle vapor compression system (Figure 16) is used to separate a solid and a liquid in an evaporator system and to separate two liquids in a distillation system. Both systems frequently have

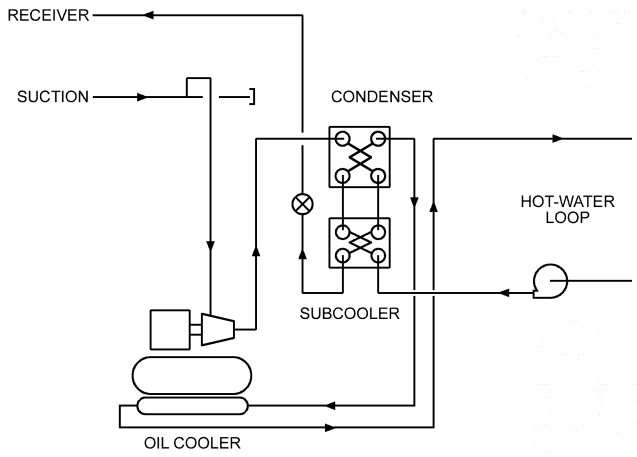


Fig. 15 Condensing Ammonia Heat Pump

(Courtesy Vilter Manufacturing and Emerson Climate Technologies)

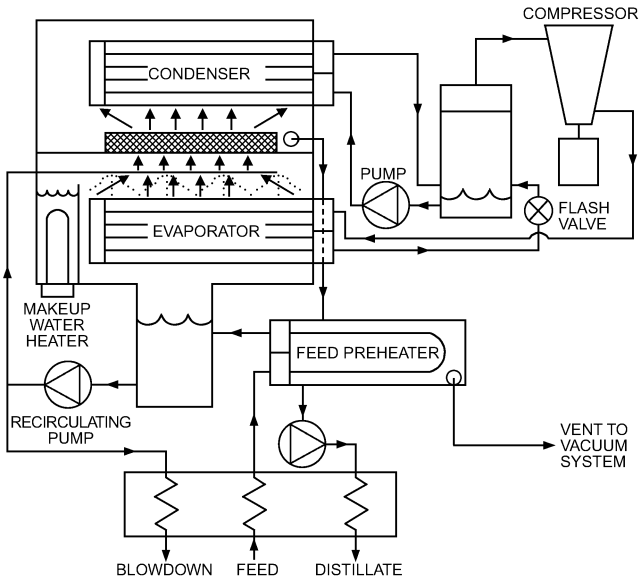


Fig. 16 Closed-Cycle Vapor Compression System

COPs of 8 to 10 and have the added benefit of cooling tower elimination. These systems can frequently be specified and supplied by the column or evaporator manufacturer as a value-added system.

The benefits of water-to-water, refrigerant-to-water, and other fluid-to-fluid systems may include the following:

- Lower energy costs because of the switch from fuel-based water heating to heat recovery water heating
- Reduced costs for water-treatment chemicals for the boiler because of the switch from a steam-based system
- Reduced emissions of NO_x, SO_x, CO, CO_2, and other harmful chemicals because of reduced boiler loading
- Decreased effluent temperature, which improves the effectiveness of the water treatment process that breaks down solids
- Increased production because of the increased water temperature available at the start of process cycles (for processes requiring a cooler start temperature, preheated water may be blended with ambient water)
- Higher product quality from rinsing with water at a higher temperature (blending preheated water with ambient water may be necessary if a cooler temperature is required)
- Reduced water and chemical consumption at cooling towers and evaporative condensers
- More efficient process cooling if heat recovery can be used to reduce refrigeration pressure or cooling tower return temperature
- Reduced scaling of heat exchangers because of the lower surface temperatures in heat pump systems compared to steam coils, forced-air gas systems, and resistance heaters

Open-Cycle and Semi-Open-Cycle Heat Pump Systems

Open- and **semi-open-cycle heat pump systems** use process fluid to raise the temperature of available heat energy by vapor compression, thus eliminating the need for chemical refrigerants. The most important class of applications is steam recompression. Compression can be provided with a mechanical compressor or by a thermocompression ejector driven by the required quantity of high-pressure steam. The three main controlling factors for this class of systems are vapor quality, boiling point elevation, and chemical makeup.

Recompression of boiler-generated process steam (Figure 17) has two major applications: (1) large facilities with substantial steam pressure drop due to line losses and (2) facilities with a considerable imbalance between steam requirements at low, medium, and high levels. Boiler-generated process steam usually conforms to cleanliness standards that ensure corrosion-free operation of the compression equipment. Evaluation of energy costs and steam value can be complicated with these applications, dictating the use of analytical tools such as pinch technology.

Application of open-cycle heat pumps to evaporation processes is exceptionally important. Single-effect **evaporators** (Figure 18) are common when relatively small volumes of water and solid need to be separated. The most frequent applications are in the food and dairy industries. The overhead vapors of the evaporator are compressed, and thus heated, and piped to the system heater (i.e., calandria). The heat is transferred to the dilute solution, which is then piped to the evaporator body. Flashing occurs upon entry to the evaporator body, sending concentrate to the bottom and vapors to the top. System COPs reach 10 to 20, and long-term performance of the evaporator improves as less of the product (and thus less build-up) occurs in the calandria because of lower operating temperatures. Multiple-effect evaporators (Figure 19), usually applied in the paper and chemical industries, use the same principles, only on a much larger scale. The multiple evaporator bodies can be piped in series or in parallel. System COPs can exceed 30.

Using open-cycle heat pumps in distillation processes (Figure 20) is similar to evaporation. However, compression of flammable gaseous compounds can be dangerous, so great care must be taken. The overhead vapors are compressed to a higher pressure and temperature, and then condensed in the reboiler. This eliminates the need for boiler steam in the reboiler and reduces overall energy consumption. As the pressure of the condensed vapor is reduced through the expansion valve, some of the liquid at a lower temperature is returned to the column as reflux, and the balance forms the overhead product, both as liquid and as vapor. Vapor is recycled as necessary. System COPs can reach 30 or 40.

Process emission-to-steam heat pump systems can be used for cooking, curing, and drying systems that operate with low-pressure saturated or superheated steam. The vapors from a cooking process, such as at a rendering plant, can be recovered to generate the steam required for cooking (Figure 21). The vapors (cooking exhaust) are compressed with a screw compressor because noncondensable materials removed from the process by the vapor could erode or damage reciprocating or centrifugal compressors. Compressed steam is then supplied to the cooker, but may require some makeup water to desuperheat the steam. The steam condenses in the cooking process, and the condensate is then used to heat process water using a heat exchanger for additional heat recovery. The system condensate cannot be recirculated to the compressor because of contaminants; instead, it is sent to the system scrubbers or cleanup system where noncondensables are usually scrubbed or incinerated, and the water is treated or discharged to a sewer.

Contaminants in some processes require the use of a semi-open-cycle heat pump (Figure 22). This system uses a heat exchanger, frequently called a **reboiler**, to recover heat from the stack gases. The reboiler produces low-pressure steam, which is compressed to the desired pressure and temperature. A clean-in-place (CIP) system may be used if the volume of contaminants is substantial.

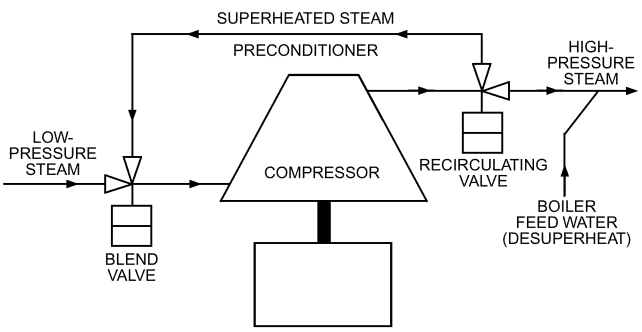


Fig. 17 Recompression of Boiler-Generated Process Steam

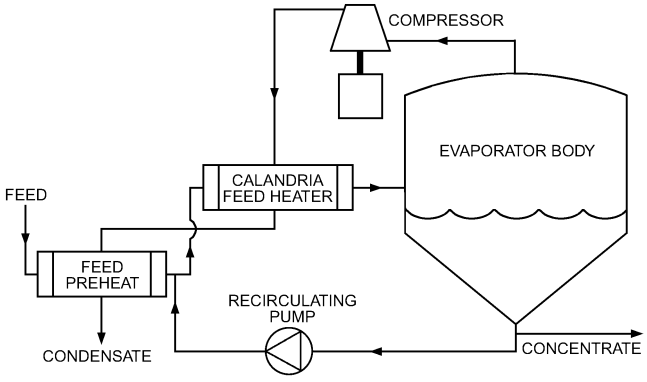


Fig. 18 Single-Effect Heat Pump Evaporator

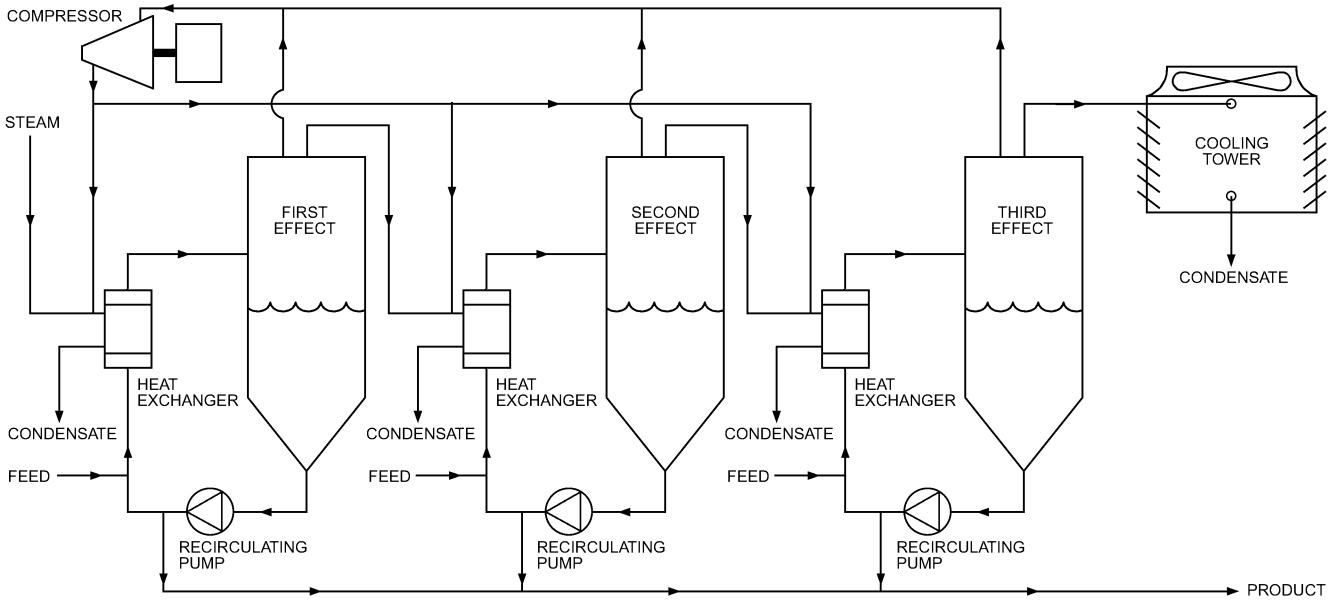


Fig. 19 Multiple-Effect Heat Pump Evaporator

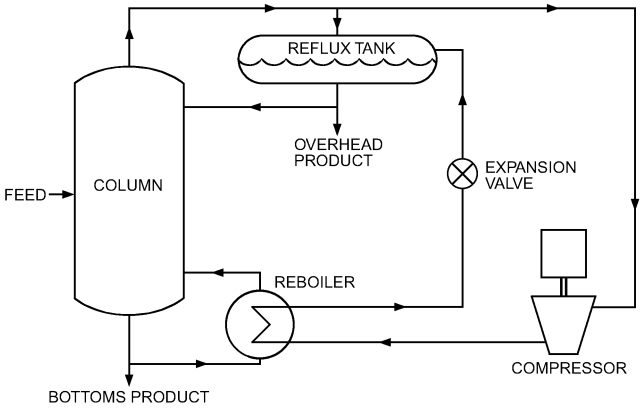


Fig. 20 Distillation Heat Pump System

Variable-speed drives can be specified with all these systems for closer, more efficient capacity control. Additional capacity for emergencies can be made available by temporarily overspeeding the drive, while sizing for nominal operating conditions to retain optimal efficiency. Proper integration of heat pump controls and system controls is essential.

Heat Recovery Design Principles

Apply the following basic principles when designing heat recovery systems:

- Use second-law, pinch technology, or other thermodynamic analysis methods, especially for complex processes, before detailed design to ensure proper thermodynamic placement of the HRHP.
- Design for base-load conditions. Heat recovery systems are designed for reduced operating costs. Process scheduling and thermal storage (usually hot water) can be used for better system balancing. Existing water-heating systems can be used for peak load periods and for better temperature control.
- Exchange heat first, and then apply heat pumps. If a heat exchanger is to provide the thermal work in a system, it should be used by itself. If additional cooling of the heat source stream and/or additional heating of the heat sink stream are needed, then a heat pump should be added.
- Do not expect a heat pump to solve a design problem. A design problem such as an unbalanced refrigeration system may be exacerbated by adding a heat pump.
- Make a complete comparison of the heat exchanger system and the heat pump system. Compared to heat exchange alone, a heat pump system has additional first and operating costs. If feasible, heat exchange should be added to the front end of the heat pump system.
- Evaluate the cost of heat displaced by the heat pump system. If the boiler operation is not changed, or if it makes the boiler less efficient, the heat pump may not be economical.
- Investigate standard fuel-handling and heat exchanger systems already used in an industry before designing the heat pump. Many industries have developed fuel-handling and heat exchanger systems designed specifically for their unique chemical and contaminant conditions.
- Industrial processes follow production loads instead of weather conditions and, therefore, the flow and temperature profile of both the heat source and heat sink over an extended period of time need to be collected and understood. The data may help prevent overestimating the requirements, thus adversely affecting the system's economics.
- Investigate future process changes that may affect the thermal requirements and/or availability of the system. Determine whether the plant is changing to a cold-water cleanup system or to a process to produce less effluent at lower temperatures.
- Design the system to give plant operators the same or better control. Thoroughly review manual versus automatic controls. Often, existing systems can provide peaking and control energy if left in series with the new HRHP.
- Determine whether special material specifications are needed for handling any process flows. Obtain a chemical analysis for any flow of unknown makeup.
- Inform equipment suppliers of the full range of ambient conditions to which the equipment will be exposed and the expected loading requirements.

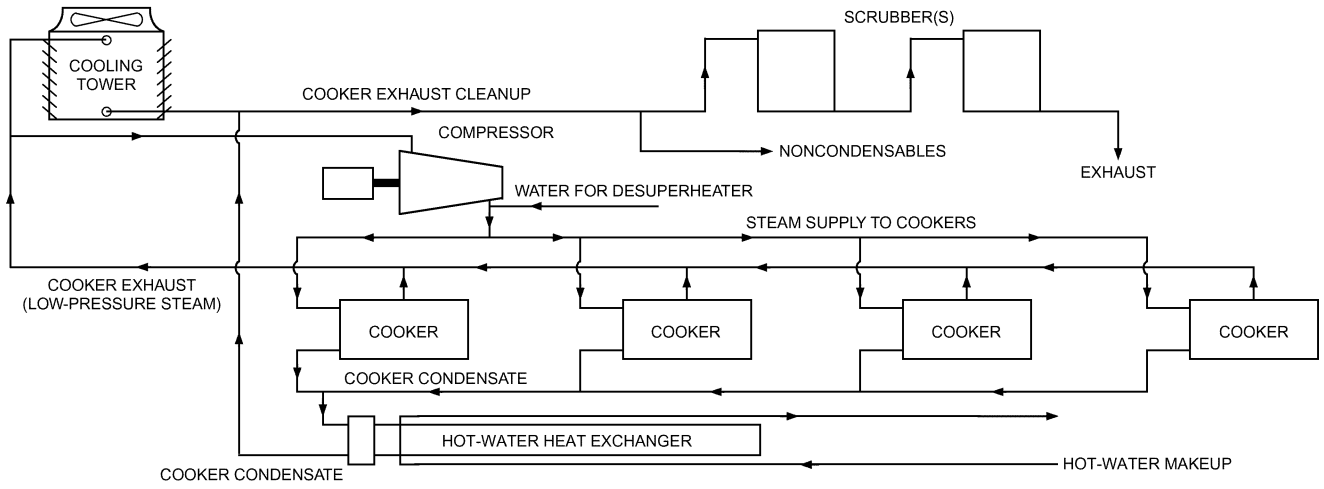


Fig. 21 Heat Recovery Heat Pump System in a Rendering Plant

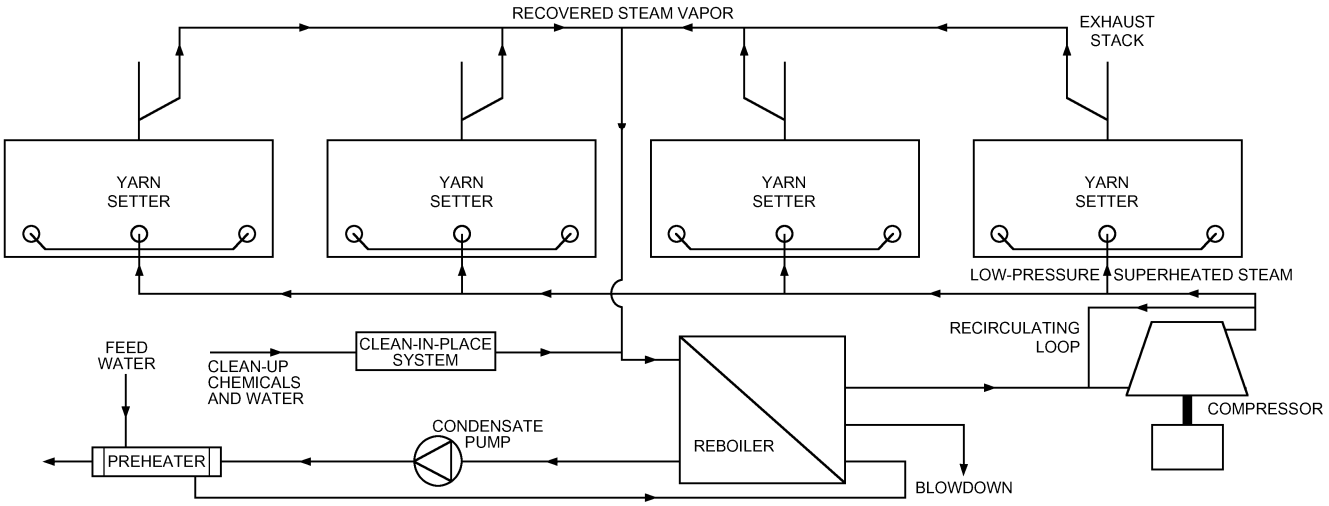


Fig. 22 Semi-Open-Cycle Heat Pump in a Textile Plant

ASHRAE research project RP-807 (Caneta Research 1998) produced guidelines for evaluating environmental benefits (e.g., energy, water, plant emission reductions) of heat recovery heat pumps. Calculation procedures for energy and water savings and plant emission reductions were outlined. Other, less easily quantified benefits were also documented. Evaluation guidelines were provided for a heat pump water heater in a hospital kitchen; a heat recovery heat pump at a resort with a spa, pool, and laundry service building; heat recovery from refrigeration compressor superheat for makeup water heating; and various drying processes using heat pumps and concentration processes. These guidelines can be used to quantify energy, water, and emission reductions and help justify using heat recovery systems in commercial, institutional, and industrial buildings.

3. APPLIED HEAT RECOVERY SYSTEMS

3.1 WASTE HEAT RECOVERY

General Considerations

In many large buildings, internal heat gains require year-round chiller operation. The chiller condenser water heat is often wasted through a cooling tower. An increasingly common approach to using this waste heat is adding a water-to-water heat pump in the chilled-water system to boost the quality of this waste heat to create hot water. This arrangement uses the otherwise wasted heat to provide the higher temperatures required for one or more of the following:

- Domestic water heating
- Terminal reheat
- Outdoor air heat
- Dehumidification
- Space heating
- Process heating

This section provides an overview of what engineers should consider before adding a heat recovery heat pump into a new or existing chilled-water system to offset less efficient means of heat production.

Note that, to ensure correct application of an HRHP, proper second-law, pinch, or other thermodynamic analysis methods should be used before applying a heat recovery heat pump in a waste heat stream. Furthermore, the ability to exchange heat before using a heat pump should always be considered first in any heat exchange process. For example, if the only area of consideration is hot water produced by a boiler, it might be more economical to investigate a heat exchanger in the cooling tower loop to preheat feed water

rather than a full mechanical system to replace the full boiler operation. This section uses the term heat recovery heat pump (HRHP) to designate a chiller that provides usable hot water as at least one of its intended roles.

Heat recovery heat pumps for waste heat recovery should be considered during any initial design, retrofit, or changeout of an existing chiller. The exact reasons for deciding on a heat recovery chiller vary, but economic justification of an HRHP is generally based on one or a combination of the following (Schwedler and Brunsvold 2011):

- Savings in fossil fuel costs, cooling tower operation and maintenance (O&M), etc.
- Reducing site emissions
- Compliance with codes and standards

Other benefits that may be considered include (Dorgan et al. 1999)

- Reduced energy use
- Reduced heating equipment size
- Increased equipment utilization factor
- Improved load balancing

Applications of Waste Heat Recovery

Though it may be possible to apply an HRHP to most hot-water needs, the specific temperature requirement of the hot water must be fully understood because it affects the overall system efficiency, availability of applicable equipment, and operating conditions of the HRHP.

Domestic Water Heat (41 to 50°C). Domestic hot-water usage volumes and patterns depend on the building type, but the application of waste heat recovery is well suited to the temperature and load factor demands of chillers used for comfort cooling. The relatively low temperature of domestic hot water can be readily met by available heat recovery heat pumps; higher-temperature domestic hot-water needs such as sanitary dishwashing and laundry services (up to 82°C) require more specialized heat recovery heat pump design. An important note for domestic hot water is the probable need for a separate or a double-walled heat exchanger to separate the chiller loop from the domestic water loop to reduce the potential contamination of potable water (Hubbard 2009). The demand factor for this application depends on the amount of the domestic water heating provided by the heat recovery system and the building type: for instance, hospitals will have a much higher demand factor than typical lavatory loads of an office building.

Terminal Reheat (38 to 50°C). Variable-air-volume (VAV) cooling systems can often require reheat for terminal zones when one air handler serves multiple zone types or mixed perimeter and internal zones. However, limits to the maximum allowable amount of reheat energy must be considered. Furthermore, when an economizer is in use, outdoor air might require heat to maintain comfort conditions if the supplied air exceeds the required cooling load. Because of the large amount of flexibility in the use of hot water for terminal reheat, the demand factor can be quite high for this application.

Dehumidification (27 to 43°C). If space supply air is overcooled for humidity control, hot-water coils can be used to heat the air for comfort control. The demand factor of this application depends on the building's space humidity control scheme.

Space Heating (35 to 71°C). Buildings requiring simultaneous heating and cooling for perimeter and interior zones, respectively, can be an ideal application of waste heat recovery because of the natural demand load balancing. The demand factor for this application can be as large as the entire heating season, depending on the space heating load.

Process Heating (Temperature Range Depends on Process). Although typically reserved for industrial processes, waste heat recovery can be used effectively in shared or distributed energy systems. However, the demand factor of this application can be as high as 100%.

Alternative Heat Sources

In applications where the heat produced by the chiller plant is not enough to provide the desired amount of heat for the heat recovery system (e.g., when a load-shedding economizer reduces the operation of a chiller plant yet there is still a perimeter heating load), consider an alternative source of "free" heat. Examples include

- Exhaust air heat recovery
- Ground heat exchangers, and other terrestrial sources of heat
- Lakes, ocean, wells, or other natural water sources
- Effluent water streams
- Waste heat sources from surrounding buildings

Locating the Heat Recovery Heat Pump

Figure 23 shows the potential locations of an HRHP in a simplified chiller loop. Note these locations are for illustration only; this figure does not show any bypass valves, pumps, control points, or auxiliary heat exchangers that may be needed in the actual layout.

Parallel Application (Location 1 in Figure 23). This is generally a high-lift chiller because it must provide a temperature lift from chilled-water ranges to usable hot-water temperatures. However, this location can provide the highest overall system savings in a new design. This unit can be the only chiller in the plant, equal-percentage loaded, or preferentially loaded. However, this application does not allow for control of the leaving hot-water temperature without a variable evaporator flow (Schwedler and Brunsvold 2011).

Sidestream Application (Location 2 in Figure 23). This is generally a high-lift machine with the simplest control sequence. This location typically operates on a constant condenser leaving water temperature, and allows for a portion of the return chilled water to flow through the unit; therefore, this unit can be used to supplement the existing chiller plant capacity and reduce the cooling tower

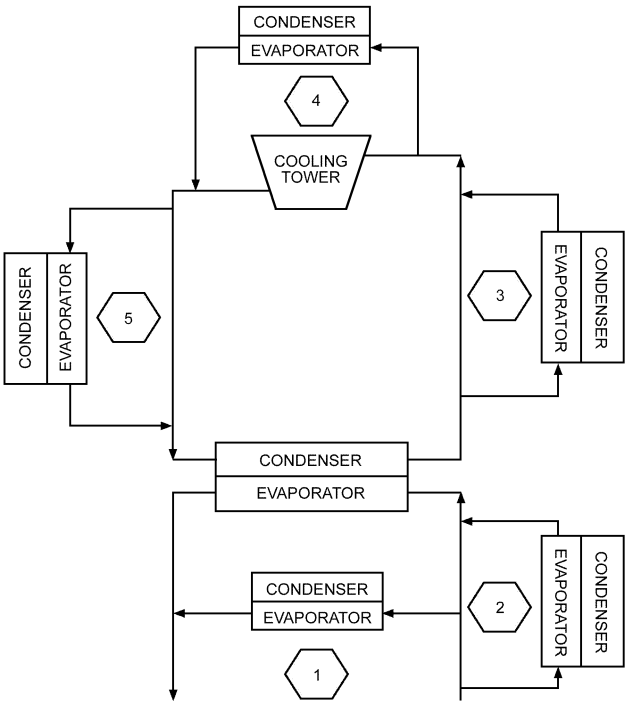


Fig. 23 Possible Heat Recovery Heat Pump Locations

capacity (Campbell et al. 2012). This application could also be used in a cascaded arrangement to provide higher lifts without specific high-lift equipment. Typical sizing strategies of this location include sizing the equipment to the loss in the chilled-water piping so the main chillers see a specific design temperature difference (e.g. 5.5°C), or sizing to the heating load only if the cooling load is much larger than the heating.

Cascade Application #1 (Location 3 in Figure 23). Here, condenser water of the main chiller plant feeds into the evaporator of the HRHP. This application is generally easily applicable in a retrofit situation, and only provides heating, whereas locations 1 and 2 can provide both chilled and heated water. However, higher water temperatures can be achieved without using "high-lift" conditions which cause relatively poor HRHP efficiencies. Because the tower loop is used in location 3, fouling must be given special consideration. Furthermore, fluctuating tower loop temperatures can affect the leaving water temperature of the HRHP, and there is no output of the HRHP if the main chiller plant is off. When a standard chiller is being used as an HRHP, it may not be capable of water temperatures greater than 18°C leaving the evaporator, because most compressor motors are suction-gas cooled, whereas open-drive systems come with a different host of concerns and considerations. Where the HRHP satisfies all or a large portion of the tower load, care must be taken to winterize the tower and provide for bypass piping. Although using an HRHP in location 3 will likely provide the lowest lift (and highest COP) for the HRHP and reduce cooling tower fan energy use, it will likely have one of the lowest impacts/improvements on the efficiency or energy usage of the chillers in the system.

Cascade Application #2 (Location 4 in Figure 23). As in location 3, the HRHP can be used to supplement the cooling tower capacity (e.g., during short tower capacity). The same considerations apply as in location 3. Special considerations must be given to maintaining flow through the tower, potential overcooling of the cooling tower loop, and the added control complexity.

Cascade Application #3 (Location 5 in Figure 23). Similar to locations 3 and 4, this site results in a higher lift requirement for the HRHP but a lower lift requirement for the main chilled water plant. Location 5 may be the most suitable position for chillers with suction-gas-cooled compressor motors in a condenser-side recovery application.

Specific Considerations of Condenser-Side Recovery

Using an HRHP on the condenser side of a chilled-water system (locations 3, 4, and 5) may allow for a smaller and/or lower lift system. However, there are specific benefits and challenges to consider in the overall effect on the building's systems.

Benefits to the cooling tower loop include the ability to design bypass piping and to bypass the cooling tower when the HRHP can absorb the total heat rejection of the condenser loop to which it is attached. Take this offloading of the cooling tower and the associated runtime reduction into account in the overall economic analysis of the HRHP system. Under low-temperature heating needs, condenser-side heat recovery can also allow use of the existing chiller with minor changes through an increase in the operating pressure ratio of an existing chiller.

Challenges associated with the application of condenser-side heat recovery include the dependency of heat recovery on the operation of the main chiller. If the loads are not coincident, the heat recovery system cannot operate without the main chiller system operating. This could significantly impact the economics of the HRHP. Additionally, fouling of the HRHP must be considered when using the condenser-loop, and isolation of the fluid streams may be required.

Furthermore, take into account the effect of the heat recovery system on the condenser loop temperature, to ensure it does not negatively affect the existing chiller system's operating ability. Although the potential to bypass the cooling tower may be a benefit, it can also be a challenge in the control of the overall system, and requires a cooling tower bypass or the ability to appropriately offload the HRHP to maintain condenser loop temperatures entering the existing chiller. However, this increased capacity on the condenser side could provide an increase in the operational efficiency of the existing chiller.

Specific Considerations of Evaporator-Side Recovery

Just as there are both benefits and challenges of condenser-side recovery, there are similar analogues with evaporator-side heat recovery (locations 1 and 2) that must be considered in the overall operational scheme and impact on the overall system.

Notable benefits of evaporator-side heat recovery include the ability to preferentially load the HRHP and provide a maximum amount of recovered heat while offloading other chillers in the system. Furthermore, the same magnitude of cooling tower savings is achieved using evaporator-side heat recovery, because the recovered heat is never sent to the cooling tower loop. The concern for fouling is also eliminated. Evaporator-side heat recovery should be analyzed in applications where expanded chiller capacity is required, if a beneficial sink of the recovered heat is available, such as those listed in the Applications of Waste Heat Recovery section.

Notable challenges associated with evaporator-side heat recovery include its effect on the overall chiller plant. Because the HRHP must have maximum runtime for payback considerations, the turndown ability of other chillers in the system must be considered. Furthermore, the low-temperature source water entering the HRHP could require a high-lift or multi-stage HRHP system to provide the required sink temperatures, which results in a chiller efficiency impact that must be considered in the economic evaluation of the HRHP system.

Special Considerations of Double-Bundle Heat Recovery

Double-bundle (or dual-condenser) systems offer a hybrid application of evaporator-side and condenser-side heat recovery with benefits of both application types. The ability to reject heat to either the cooling tower loop or the heat recovery loop enables flexibility in the application of an HRHP system. Though the challenges mentioned above should still be considered. The double-bundle application is not specifically covered in the applications presented in this chapter.

Selecting a Compressor Type

It is extremely important to understand the loading and unloading ability of the type of machine selected for energy recovery capability and the impact this ability has on overall system and equipment efficiency. Both dynamic (or turbomachinery) and positive displacement compressors must be considered and their impact thoroughly noted. During system and compressor selection, consideration should be given to

- Turndown ability and ratio of compressor type
- Impact to efficiency over operating range
- Available lift of compressor type
- Stages required to achieve desired lift
- Impact to existing chiller system
- Surge consideration
- O&M needs and facility capabilities
- Refrigerant usage

Chapters 38 and 43 discuss compressors in detail and covers many of the considerations listed above.

A compressor should not be allowed to enter the surge region on any machine, but specifically for an HRHP, a system should be checked for its ability to unload at the expected condenser conditions (Schwedler and Brunsvold 2011).

Pumping Considerations

Multiple options exist for control points on condenser water flow, including variable or constant flow. The chilled-water flow equally has options, including primary/secondary variable flow (Figure 24) or variable primary (Figure 25) schemes. Each of these flow conditions will greatly impact the operation of the HRHP system and its ability to reach its desired heating conditions. Descriptions of these configurations are given in the System Flow Design section of Chapter 3.

For HRHP condenser water flow, it is important to understand the turndown and unloading characteristics of the HRHP system. A constant-flow condenser system can be controlled based on a constant leaving-water temperature or a constant entering-water temperature, each of which has a distinctive impact on the unloading of the HRHP (Schwedler and Brunsvold 2011).

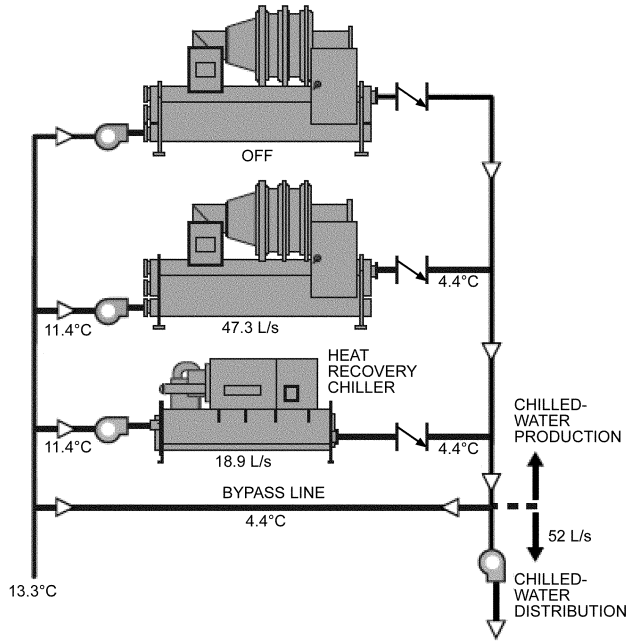


Fig. 24 Primary/Secondary, Equal Loading

(Schwedler and Brunsvold 2011)

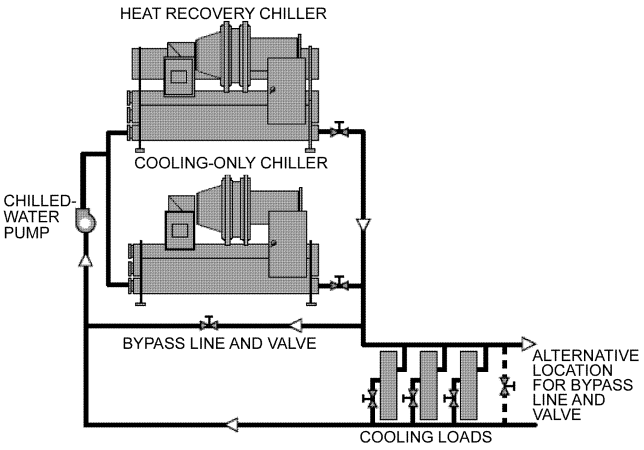


Fig. 25 Variable Primary Flow Example

(Schwedler and Brunsvold 2011)

HRHP Selection

Once potential uses and their associated temperature needs are known, steps can be taken to evaluate the heat recovery potential of the system. Higher leaving-water temperatures may reduce the cost of airside equipment, but the higher lift required by the HRHP will have associated equipment and operating cost implications. Therefore, the application must be analyzed from a system scale, both before and after application of an HRHP, to ensure the optimal capital and operating cost balance is met. Note that it is always more beneficial to exchange heat rather than apply a heat pump system. Therefore, before sizing an HRHP, search for opportunities to recover heat through heat exchange rather than moving heat with heat pumps.

An HRHP must be able to reject all of its condenser heat at all times, and must therefore be able to either always reject 100% of its load or have appropriate turndown. Therefore, it is imperative to fully analyze annual source and sink loads to ensure the unit is not oversized.

Before sizing an HRHP, an annual hourly inventory of loads should be collected, including

- Building heating and cooling loads for exterior zones
- Building heating and cooling loads for interior zones
- Occupied and unoccupied schedules
- Heat source/sink temperatures and flow rates
- Process loads
- Domestic hot-water (DHW) loads

Dorgan et al. (1999) outline four steps for applying an HRHP, as shown in Figure 26.

Step 1. Evaluate heating and cooling loads, including all loads identified in the inventory. Multiple methods are recommended for evaluation of the building loads, including bin and full hourly analysis. However, the loads should be used to create a heat balance chart similar to Figures 27 and 28. Figure 27 illustrates a building with significantly different occupied and unoccupied periods and unbalanced loads, which requires deeper analysis to ensure the proper size of the HRHP. Figure 28 shows a more balanced load condition and the point at which the HRHP rejects all of its heat produced.

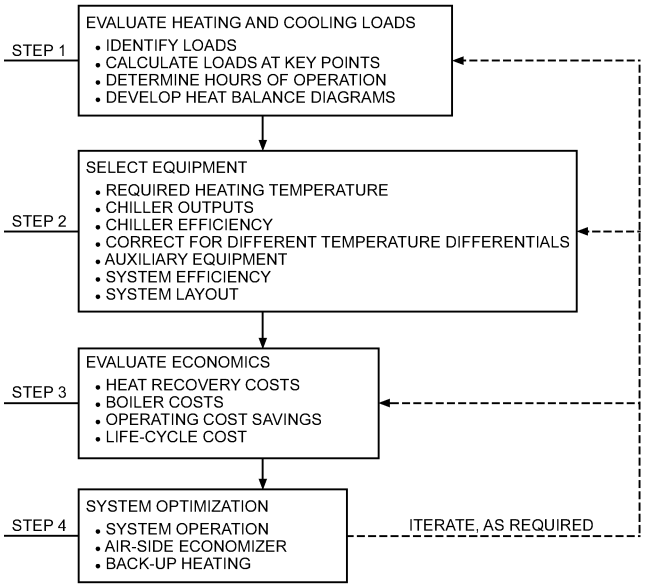


Fig. 26 HRHP Application Flowchart

(Dorgan et al. 1999)

In a situation where the available heat source outweighs the heat sink loads, the HRHP can be sized to the peak heating load, as long as the HRHP's turndown can match the heating load's variability. However, in a simultaneous heating and cooling situation, the ideal goal is to turn off the chiller in the winter and turn off the boiler in the summer, as shown in Figure 29. Note that, in Figure 29, supplemental cooling and heating are required where the HRHP (or water-to-water heat pump [WTWHP] here) cannot provide the required capacities. This case assumes the HRHP is preferentially loaded on the chilled-water loop while also providing heat recovery benefit with the condenser. In cold temperatures, as the heating load rises, the remaining heat load must be covered by an auxiliary heat source. This is the case with any HRHP system.

Step 2. Once the required loads are understood, including the temperature requirement of the heat recovery loop and the available heat to be recovered, the system type can be selected. Special attention should be paid to the compressor type and turndown ability. Perhaps most importantly, attention should be paid to the corrected capacity and efficiency impacts on the HRHP and other chillers in the system as a result of application of the HRHP system. Condenser- and evaporator-side temperature changes affect capacities of all chillers in the system, and their effects on overall efficiency must be known for economic analysis.

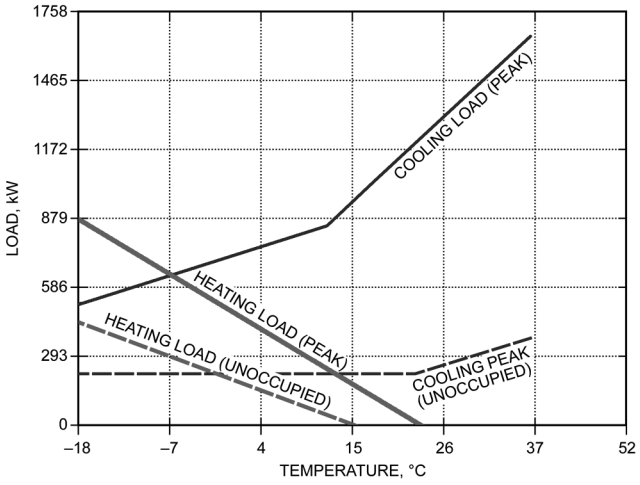


Fig. 27 Heat Balance Chart

(Dorgan et al. 1999)

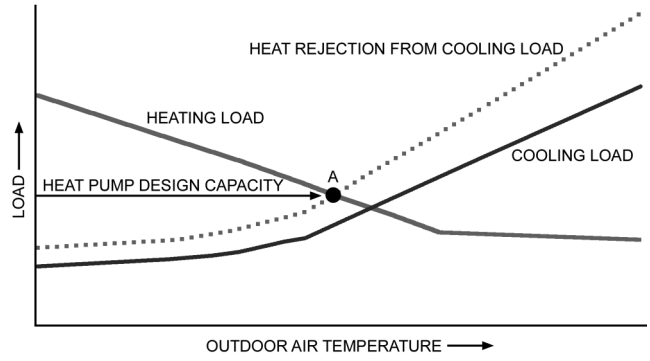


Fig. 28 Selection of Simultaneous Heating and Cooling HRHP

(Campbell et al. 2012)

Once an HRHP system is selected, the appropriate auxiliary source should be selected or analyzed if auxiliary heating will be required at any time throughout the year. If no heating system is present, as in a new design, select one with proper consideration of capacity and inlet water temperatures. For an existing plant, analyze the existing heating source for applicability to the altered system, including analysis of turndown, inlet water temperature, operating hours, etc.

Steps 3 and 4. These steps are usually iterative and include analysis of the optimal HRHP size based on its effects on the overall chiller system and the owner's economic requirements. Economic analysis of the HRHP system must be completed as an analysis of the overall plant efficiency. Include overall energy increases and decreases, such as

- Pumping energy
- Fuel consumption (fossil and electric)
- Existing chiller energy consumption (could be greater or less than base case depending on application and layout)
- Tower costs (fan, pump, water, chemicals, maintenance, etc.)
- Chilled- and hot-water savings if both are produced by the HRHP
- Water savings from reduced makeup water needed for cooling towers

Payback analysis should be calculated as required by the owner with respect to capital available, environmental impact, site-specific utility costs, discount rates, available tax benefits or rebates, etc. However, much of this information should be known at the beginning of the selection process, to inform the amount of heat recovery that should be pursued.

The final steps should include final system layout and control sequence definitions.

Example

A detailed example of HRHP application, including load analysis, equipment selection, and economic evaluation, can be found in Dorgan et al. (1999).

3.2 WATER-LOOP HEAT PUMP SYSTEMS

Description

A water-loop heat pump (WLHP) system combines load transfer characteristics with multiple water-to-air heat pump units (Figure 30). Each zone, or space, has one or more water-to-air heat pumps. The units in both the building core and perimeter areas are connected hydronically with a common two-pipe system; however, one-pipe approaches have been proven to be highly effective if designed to take advantage of the less complex system layout. Each unit cools conventionally, supplying air to the individual zone and

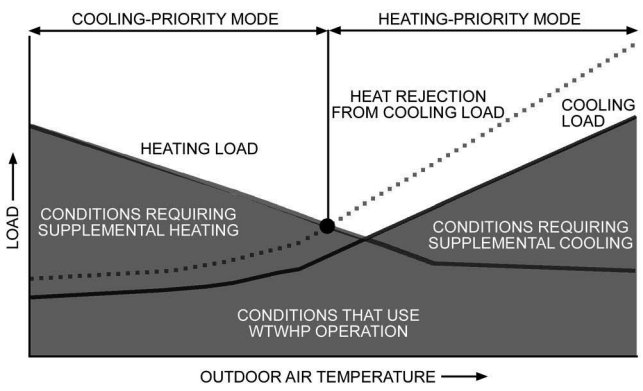


Fig. 29 Operating Areas for Simultaneous HRHP

(Campbell et al. 2012)

rejecting the heat removed to the two-pipe system through its integral condenser. Excess heat gathered by the two-pipe system is expelled through a common heat rejection device, which often includes a closed-circuit evaporative cooling tower with an integral spray pump. If and when some of the zones, particularly on the northern side of the building, require heat, the individual units switch (by means of reversing refrigerant valves) into the heating cycle. These units then extract heat from the two-pipe water loop, a relatively high-temperature source that is totally or partially maintained by heat rejected from the condensers of the units that provide cooling to other zones. When only heating is required, all units are in the heating cycle and, consequently, an external heat input to the loop is needed to maintain the loop temperature. The water-loop temperature has traditionally been maintained in the range of 16 to 32°C and, therefore, seldom requires piping insulation. However, extended-range water-loop heat pumps are becoming more common because they provide high efficiency over a wider operating range. The expanded operating range (7 to 43°C) reduces boiler and cooling tower operating costs. The lower operating temperatures may require insulating the main supply and return lines. These units typically come equipped with insulated water-to-refrigerant heat exchangers, loss-of-flow protection, and thermoexpansion valves instead of the traditional capillary tube expansion device.

Any number of water-to-air heat pumps may be installed in such a system. Water circulates through each unit via the closed loop.

The water circuit can include two circulating pumps (one pump is 100% standby) or may use variable-speed drives and a means for adding and rejecting heat to and from the loop. Each heat pump can either heat or cool to maintain the comfort level in each zone. Detailed information on the piping and pumping design for closed-loop water-to-air heat pump systems can be found in Chapter 35 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—Applications* and Chapter 6 of Kavanaugh and Rafferty (2014).

Units in heating mode extract heat from the circulated water, whereas those in cooling mode reject heat to the water. Thus, the system recovers and redistributes heat, where needed. Unlike air-source heat pumps, heating output for this system does not depend on outdoor temperature. The water loop conveys rejected heat, but a secondary heat source, typically a boiler, is usually provided.

Another WLHP version uses a coil buried in the ground as a heat source and sink. This ground-coupled system does not normally need the boiler and cooling tower incorporated in conventional WLHP systems to keep circulating water within acceptable temperature limits. However, ground-coupled heat pumps may operate at lower entering water (or antifreeze solution) temperatures. Some applications may require a heat pump tolerant of entering water temperatures ranging from –4 to 43°C. In climates where air conditioning dominates, a cooling tower is sometimes combined with ground coupling to reduce overall installed costs. Such hybrid systems are covered in more detail in Chapter 35 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—Applications* and Chapter 6 of Kavanaugh and Rafferty (2014).

Figure 31 shows a system with a storage tank and solar collectors. The storage tank in the condenser circuit can store excess heat during occupied hours and provide heat to the loop during unoccupied hours. During this process, solar heat may also be added within the limitations of the temperatures of the condenser system. The solar collectors are more effective and efficient under these circumstances because of the temperature ranges involved.

For further heat reclaim, a water-to-water heat pump can be added in the closed water loop before the heat rejection device. This heat pump provides domestic hot water or elevates loop water temperatures in a storage tank so the water can be bled back into the loop when needed during the heating cycle. Figure 32 shows such a system.

Many facilities require large cooling loads (e.g., for interior zones, lights, people, business machines, computers, switchgear, and production machinery) that result in net loop heat rejection during all or most of the year, particularly during occupied hours. This waste heat rejection often occurs while other heating loads in

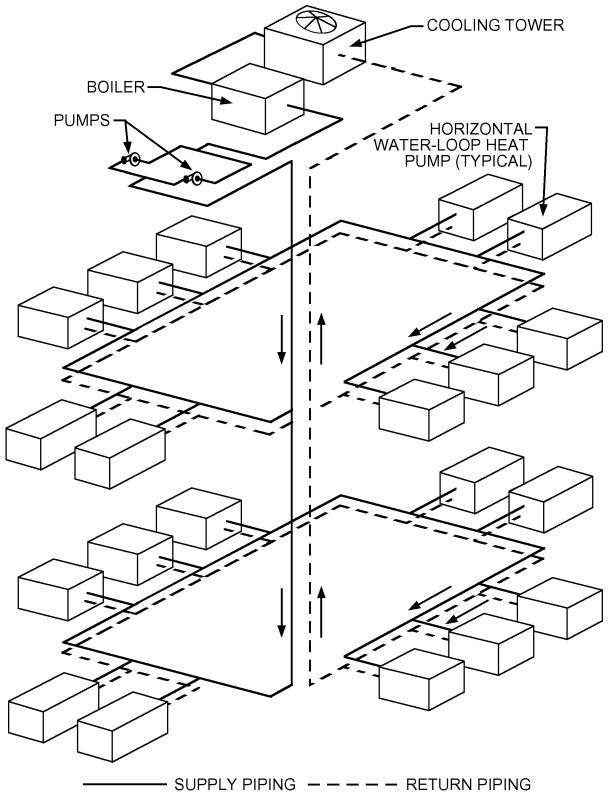


Fig. 30 Heat Recovery System Using Water-to-Air Heat Pumps in a Closed Loop

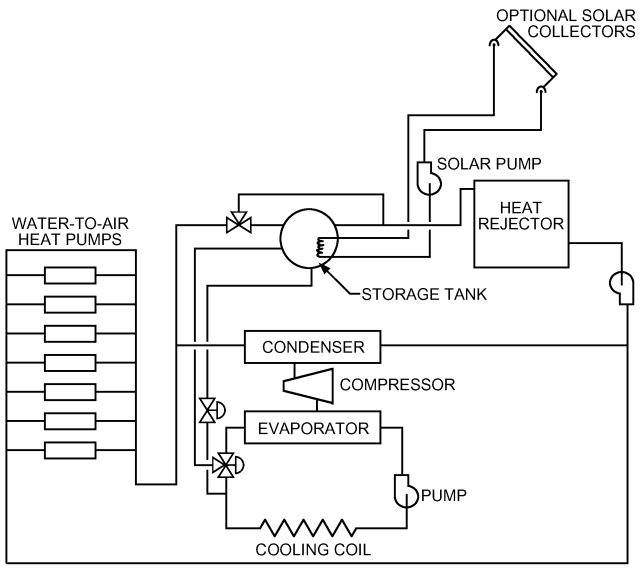


Fig. 31 Closed-Loop Heat Pump System with Thermal Storage and Optional Solar-Assist Collectors

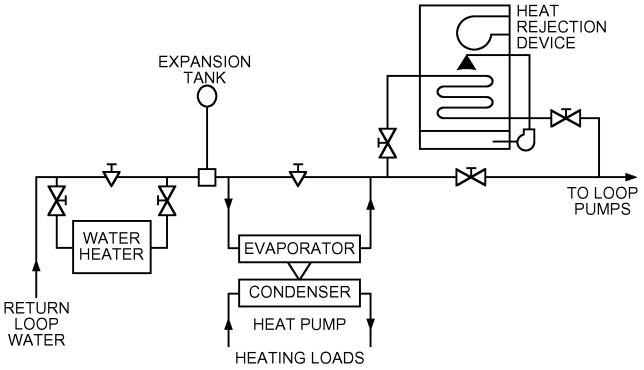


Fig. 32 Secondary Heat Recovery from WLHP System

(Adapted from *Marketing the Industrial Heat Pump*, Edison Electric Institute 1989)

the facility (e.g., ventilation air, reheat, domestic hot water) are using external purchased energy to supply heat. By including a secondary water-to-water heat pump (as in Figure 32), additional balanced heat recovery can be economically achieved. The secondary heat pump can effectively reclaim this otherwise rejected heat, raise its temperature, and use it to serve other heating loads, thus minimizing use of purchased energy.

In another WLHP system variation, the building sprinkler system is used as part of the loop water distribution system.

Some aspects of systems described in this section may be proprietary and should not be used without appropriate investigation.

Design Considerations

Water-loop heat pump (WLHP) systems are used in many types of multiroom buildings. A popular application is in office buildings, where heat gains from interior zones can be redistributed to the perimeter during winter. Other applications include hotels and motels, schools, apartment buildings, nursing homes, manufacturing facilities, and hospitals. Operating costs for these systems are most favorable in applications with simultaneous heating and cooling requirements.

Accurate design tools are needed to model and predict WLHP energy use and electrical demand. ASHRAE research project RP-620 (Cane et al. 1993) evaluated computer models for water-loop heat pump systems and compared the accuracy of the test models with actual monitored data from buildings with similar systems. Although the computer programs predicted whole-building energy use within 1 to 15% of measured total energy use over a 12-month period, much larger variations were found at the HVAC system and component levels.

Cane et al. (1993) concluded that the models could be improved by

- Modeling each heat pump rather than lumping performance characteristics of all heat pumps in one zone
- Assuming water-to-air heat pumps cycle on/off to satisfy loads, which increases energy consumption, rather than assuming they unload as a chiller would
- Being able to model thermal storage added to the water loop and service water preheat from the loop

Unit Types. Chapter 48 describes various types and styles of units and the control options available.

Zoning. The WLHP system offers excellent zoning capability. Because equipment can be placed within the zones, future relocation of partitions can be accommodated with minimum duct changes. Some systems use heat pumps for perimeter zones and the top floor, with cooling-only units serving interior zones; all units are connected into the same loop water circuit.

Heat Recovery and Heat Storage. WLHPs work well for heat storage. Installations, such as schools, that cool most of the day in winter and heat at night make excellent use of heat storage. Water may be stored in a large tank in the closed-loop circuit ahead of the boiler. In this application, the loop temperature is allowed to build up to 32°C during the day. Stored water at 32°C can be used during unoccupied hours to maintain heat in the building, with the loop temperature allowed to drop to 16°C. The water heater (or boiler) would not be used until the loop temperature had dropped the entire 16 K. The storage tank operates as a flywheel to prolong the period of operation where neither heat makeup nor heat rejection is required.

Concealed Units. Equipment installed in ceiling spaces must have access for maintenance and servicing filters, control panels, compressors, and so forth. Adequate condensate drainage must be provided.

Ventilation. Outdoor air for ventilation may be (1) ducted from a ventilation supply system to the units or (2) drawn in directly through a damper into the individual units. To operate satisfactorily, air entering the water-source heat pumps should be above 16°C. In cold climates, ventilation air must be preheated. The quantity of ventilation air entering directly through individual units can vary greatly because of stack effect, wind, and balancing difficulties.

Secondary Heat Source. The secondary heat source for heat makeup may be electric, gas, oil, ground, solar energy, and/or waste heat. Normally, a water heater or boiler is used; however, electric resistance heat in the individual heat pumps, with suitable controls, may also be used. The control may be an aquastat set to switch from heat pump to resistance heaters when the loop water approaches the minimum 16°C.

However, extreme caution is needed when defining the control sequence of the secondary heat source: after design, any alteration in set point can negatively affect system performance. If the boiler's cut-in temperature is raised, the resulting excess heat can unnecessarily heat the ground; lowering the cut-in temperature can reduce system efficiency of the water-loop heat pumps. High-temperature water entering the ground loop could cause high-density polyethylene (HDPE) tubing failure.

An electric boiler is readily controllable to provide 16°C outlet water and can be used directly in the loop. With a gas- or oil-fired combustion boiler, a heat exchanger may be used to transfer heat to the loop or, depending on the type of boiler used, a modulating valve may blend hot water from the boiler into the loop.

Solar or ground energy can supply part or all of the secondary heat. Water or antifreeze solution circulated through collectors can add heat to the system directly or indirectly via a secondary heat exchanger.

A building with night setback may need a supplementary heater boiler sized for the installed capacity, not the building heat loss, because the morning warm-up cycle may require every heat pump to operate at full heating capacity until the building is up to temperature. In this case, based on a typical heating COP of 4.0 for a water-source heat pump, the boiler would be sized to provide about 75% of the total heating capacity of all water-source heat pumps installed in the building.

Heat Rejector Selection. A closed-loop circuit requires a heat rejector that is either a heat exchanger (loop water to cooling tower water), a closed-circuit evaporative cooler, or a ground coil. The heat rejector is selected in accordance with manufacturer's selection curves, using the following parameters:

- **Water flow rates.** Manufacturers' recommendations on water flow rates vary between 40 and 50 mL/s per kilowatt of installed cooling capacity. Lower flow rates are generally preferred in regions with a relatively low summer outdoor design wet-bulb temperature. In more humid climates, a higher flow rate allows a

higher water temperature to be supplied from the heat rejector to the heat pumps, without a corresponding increase in temperature leaving the heat pumps. Thus, cooling tower or evaporative cooler size and cost are minimized without penalizing the performance of the heat pumps.

- **Water temperature range.** Range (the difference between leaving and entering water temperatures at the heat rejector) is affected by heat pump cooling efficiency, water flow rate, and diversity. It is typically between 5 and 8 K.
- **Approach.** Approach is the difference between the water temperature leaving the cooler and the wet-bulb temperature of the outdoor air. The maximum water temperature expected in the loop supply is a function of the design wet-bulb temperature.
- **Diversity.** Diversity is the maximum instantaneous cooling load of the building divided by the installed cooling capacity:

$$D = Q_m/Q_i \quad (1)$$

where

D = diversity
Q_m = maximum instantaneous cooling load
Q_i = total installed cooling capacity

Diversity times the average range of the heat pumps is the applied range of the total system (the rise through all units and the drop through the heat rejector). For systems with a constant pumping rate regardless of load,

$$R_s = DR_p \quad (2)$$

where

R_s = range of system
R_p = average range of heat pumps

For systems with a variable pumping rate and with each pump equipped with a solenoid valve to start and stop water flow through the unit with compressor operation,

$$R_s \approx R_p \quad (3)$$

The average leaving water temperature of the heat pumps is the entering water temperature of the heat rejector. The leaving water temperature of the heat rejector is the entering water temperature of the heat pumps.

- **Winterization.** For buildings with some potential year-round cooling (e.g., office buildings), loop water may be continuously pumped through the heat rejector. This control procedure reduces the danger of freezing. However, it is important to winterize the heat rejector to minimize the heat loss.

In northern climates, the most important winterization step for evaporative coolers is installing a discharge air plenum with positive-closure, motorized, ice-proof dampers. The entire casing that houses the tube bundle and discharge plenum may be insulated. The sump, if outside the heated space, should be equipped with electric heaters. The heat pump equipment manufacturer's instructions will help in the selection and control of the heat rejector.

If sections of the water circuit will be exposed to freezing temperatures, consider adding an antifreeze solution. In a serpentine pipe circuit with no automatic valves that could totally isolate individual components, an antifreeze solution prevents bursting pipes, with minimal effect on system performance.

An open cooling tower with a separate heat exchanger is a practical alternative to the closed water cooler (Figure 33). An additional pump is required to circulate the tower water through the heat exchanger. In such an installation, where no tubes are exposed to the atmosphere, it may not be necessary to provide freeze protection on the tower. The sump may be indoors or, if outdoors, may be heated to keep the water from freezing. This arrangement allows the use of small, remotely located towers.

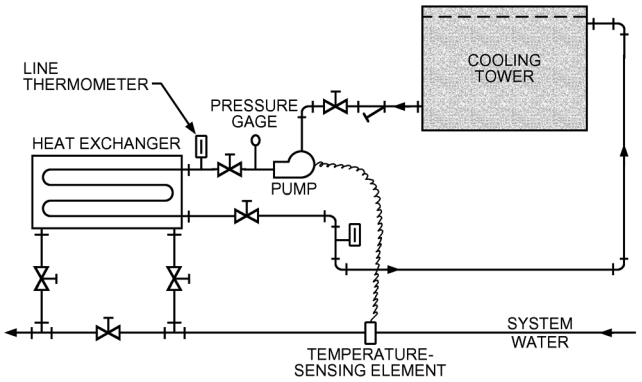


Fig. 33 Cooling Tower with Heat Exchanger

Temperature control necessary for tower operation is maintained by a sensor in the water-loop system controlling operation of the tower fan(s).

The combination of an open tower, heat exchanger, and tower pump frequently has a lower first cost than an evaporative cooler. In addition, operating costs are lower because no heat is lost from the loop in winter and, frequently, less power is required for the cooling tower fans.

Ductwork Layout. Often, a WLHP system has ceiling-concealed units, and the ceiling area is used as the return plenum. Troffered light fixtures are a popular means of returning air to the ceiling plenum.

Air supply from the heat pumps should be designed for quiet operation. Heat pumps connected to ductwork must be capable of overcoming external static pressure. Heat pump manufacturers' recommendations should be consulted for the maximum and minimum external static pressure allowable with each piece of equipment. However, note that using smaller units and less ductwork is generally preferable, to maximize efficiency.

Piping Layout. Reverse-return piping should be used wherever possible with the WLHP system, particularly when all units have essentially the same capacity. Balancing is then minimized except for each of the system branches. If direct-return piping is used, balancing water flow is required at each individual heat pump. The entire system flow may circulate through the boiler and heat rejector in series. Water makeup should be at the constant-pressure point of the entire water loop. Piping system design is similar to the secondary water distribution of air-and-water systems. Detailed information on the piping and pumping design can be found in Chapter 35 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—Applications* and Chapter 6 of Kavanaugh and Rafferty (2014).

Pumping costs for a WLHP system can be significant. Because system loads vary considerably, variable-speed pumping should be considered. This requires an automatic valve at each heat pump that allows water flow through the heat pump coil only during compressor operation.

Clean piping is vital to successful performance of the water-source heat pump system. The pipe should be clean when installed, kept clean during construction, and thoroughly cleaned and flushed upon completion of construction. Start-up water filters in the system bypass (pump discharge to suction) should be included on large, extensive systems.

Controls

The WLHP system has simpler controls than totally central systems. Each heat pump is controlled by a thermostat in the zone. There are only two centralized temperature control points: one to add heat when the water temperature approaches a prescribed lower

temperature (7 to 16°C), and the other to reject heat when the water temperature approaches a prescribed upper temperature (typically about 32 to 38°C).

The boiler controls should be checked to be sure that outlet water is controlled at 16°C, because controls normally supplied with boilers are in a much higher range.

An evaporative cooler should be controlled by increasing or decreasing heat rejection capacity in response to the loop water temperature leaving the cooler. A reset schedule that operates the system at a lower water temperature (to take advantage of lower outdoor wet-bulb temperatures) can save energy when heat from the loop storage is not likely to be used.

Abnormal condition alarms typically operate as follows:

- On a fall in loop temperature to 10°C, initiate an alert. Open heat pump control circuits at 7°C.
- On a rise in loop temperature to 40°C, initiate an alert. Open heat pump control circuits at 43°C.
- On sensing insufficient system water flow, a flow switch initiates an alert and opens the heat pump control circuits.

Outdoor ambient control should be provided to prevent operation of the cooling tower sump pump at freezing temperatures.

Optional system control arrangements include the following:

- Night setback control
- Automatic unit start/stop, with after-hour restart as a tenant option
- Warm-up cycle
- Pump alternator control

Advantages of a WLHP System

- Affords opportunity for energy conservation by recovering heat from interior zones and/or waste heat and by storing excess heat from daytime cooling for nighttime or other heating uses.
- Allows recovery of solar energy at a relatively low fluid temperature where solar collector efficiency is likely to be greater.
- The building does not require wall penetrations to provide for the rejection of heat from air-cooled condensers.
- Provides environmental control in scattered occupied zones during nights or weekends without the need to start a large central refrigeration machine.
- Units are not exposed to outdoor weather, which allows installation in coastal and other corrosive atmospheres.
- Units have a longer service life than air-cooled heat pumps. Tables 3 and 4 in Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* list service life for equipment types.
- Noise levels can be lower than those of air-cooled equipment because condenser fans are eliminated and the compression ratio is lower.
- Two-pipe boiler/chiller systems are potentially convertible to this system.
- The entire system is not shut down when a unit fails. However, loss of pumping capability, heat rejection, or secondary heating could affect the entire system.
- Energy usage by the heat pumps can be metered for each tenant. However, this metering would not include energy consumed by the central pump, heat rejector, or boiler.
- Total life-cycle cost of this system frequently compares favorably to that of central systems when considering installed cost, operating costs, and system life.
- Units can be installed as space is leased or occupied.

Limitations of a WLHP System

- Space is required for the boiler, heat exchangers, pumps, and heat rejector.
- Initial cost may be higher than for systems that use multiple unitary HVAC equipment.
- With some, more basic WLHP equipment, reduced airflow can cause the heat pump to overheat and cut out. Therefore, periodic filter maintenance is imperative.
- The piping loop must be kept clean.

3.3 BALANCED HEAT RECOVERY SYSTEMS

Definition

In an ideal heat recovery system, all components work year-round to recover all the internal heat before adding external heat. Any excess heat is either stored or rejected. Such an idealized goal is identified as a balanced heat recovery system. Note that "balanced" refers to operation of the heat recovery system; loads will rarely match perfectly year round.

When the outdoor temperature drops significantly, or when the building is shut down (e.g., on nights and weekends), internal heat gain may be insufficient to meet the space heating requirements. Then, a balanced system provides heat from storage or an external source. When internal heat is again generated, the external heat is automatically reduced to maintain proper temperature in the space. There is a time delay before equilibrium is reached. The size of the equipment and the external heat source can be reduced in a balanced system that includes storage. Regardless of the system, a heat balance analysis establishes the merits of balanced heat recovery at various outdoor temperatures.

Outdoor air less than 13 to 18°C may be used to cool building spaces with an air economizer cycle. When considering this method of cooling, the space required by ducts, air shafts, and fans, as well as the increased filtering requirements to remove contaminants and the hazard of possible freeze-up of dampers and coils must be weighed against alternatives such as using deep row coils with antifreeze fluids and efficient heat exchange. Innovative use of heat pump principles may give considerable energy savings and more satisfactory human comfort than an air economizer. In any case, hot and cold air should not be mixed (if avoidable) to control zone temperatures because it wastes energy.

Heat Redistribution

Many buildings, especially those with computers or large interior areas, generate more heat than can be used for most of the year. Operating cost is minimized when the system changes over from net heating to net cooling at the break-even outdoor temperature at which the building heat loss equals the internal heat load. If heat is unnecessarily rejected or added to the space, the changeover temperature varies from the natural break-even temperature, and operating costs increase. Heating costs can be reduced or eliminated if excess heat is stored for later distribution.

Heat Balance Concept

The concept of ideal heat balance in an overall building project or a single space requires that one of the following takes place on demand:

- Heat must be removed.
- Heat must be added.
- Heat recovered must exactly balance the heat required, in which case heat should be neither added nor removed.

In small air-conditioning projects serving only one space, either cooling or heating satisfies the thermostat demand. If humidity control is not required, operation is simple. Assuming both heating and cooling are available, automatic controls will respond to the thermostat to supply either. A system should not heat and cool the same space simultaneously.

Multiroom buildings commonly require heating in some rooms and cooling in others. Optimum design considers the building as a whole and transfers excess internal heat from one area to another, as required, without introducing external heat that would require waste

heat disposal at the same time. The heat balance concept is violated when this occurs.

Humidity control must also be considered. Any system should add or remove only enough heat to maintain the desired temperature and control the humidity. Large percentages of outdoor air with high wet-bulb temperatures, as well as certain types of humidity control, may require reheat, which could upset the desirable balance. Usually, humidity control can be obtained without upsetting the balance. When reheat is unavoidable, internally transferred heat from heat recovery should always be used to the extent it is available, before using an external heat source such as a boiler. However, the effect of the added reheat must be analyzed, because it affects the heat balance and may have to be treated as a variable internal load.

When a building requires heat and the refrigeration plant is not in use, dehumidification is not usually required and the outdoor air is dry enough to compensate for any internal moisture gains. This should be carefully reviewed for each design.

Heat Balance Studies

The following examples illustrate situations that can occur in nonrecovery and unbalanced heat recovery situations. Figure 34 shows the major components of a building that comprise the total air-conditioning load. Values above the zero line are cooling loads, and values below the zero line are heating loads. On an individual basis, the ventilation and conduction loads cross the zero line, which indicates that these loads can be a heating or a cooling load, depending on outdoor temperature. Solar and internal loads are always a cooling load and are, therefore, above the zero line.

Figure 35 combines all the loads shown in Figure 34. The graph is obtained by plotting the conduction load of a building at various outdoor temperatures, and then adding or subtracting the other loads at each temperature. The project load lines, with and without solar effect, cross the zero line at –9 and –1°C, respectively. These are the outdoor temperatures for the plotted conditions when the naturally created internal load exactly balances the loss.

As plotted, this heat balance diagram includes only the building loads with no allowance for additional external heat from a boiler or other source. If external heat is necessary because of system design, the diagram should include the additional heat.

Figure 36 shows what happens when heat recovery is not used. It assumes that, at a temperature of 21°C, heat from an external source is added to balance conduction through the building's skin in increasing amounts down to the minimum outdoor temperature winter design condition. Figure 36 also adds the heat required for the outdoor air intake. The outdoor air comprising part or all of the supply air must be heated from outdoor temperature to room temperature. Only the temperature range above the room temperature is effective for heating to balance the perimeter conduction loss.

These loads are plotted at the minimum outdoor winter design temperature, resulting in a new line passing through points A, D, and E. This line crosses the zero line at –35°C, which becomes the artificially created break-even temperature rather than –1°C, when not allowing for solar effect. When the sun shines, the added solar heat at the minimum design temperature would further drop the –35°C break-even temperature. Such a design adds more heat than the overall project requires and does not use balanced heat recovery to use the available internal heat. This problem is most evident during mild weather on systems not designed to take full advantage of internally generated heat year-round.

The following are two examples of situations that can be shown in a heat balance study:

1. As the outdoor air wet-bulb temperature drops, the total heat of the air falls. If a mixture of outdoor and recirculated air is cooled to 13°C in summer and the same dry-bulb temperature is supplied by an economizer cycle for interior space cooling in winter,

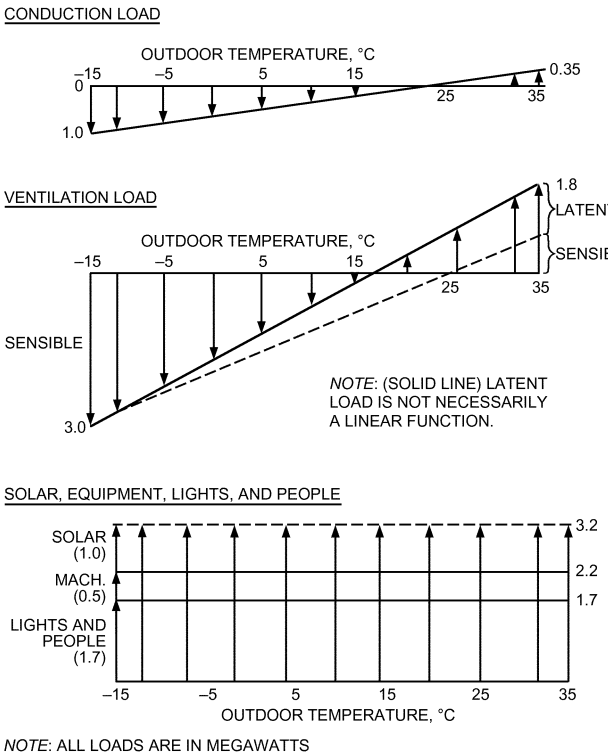


Fig. 34 Major Load Components

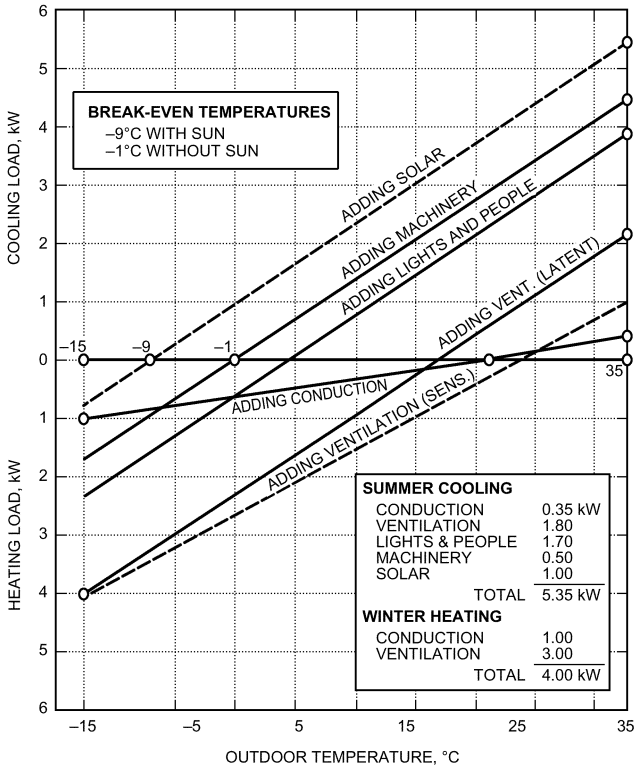


Fig. 35 Composite Plot of Loads in Figure 34 (Adjust for Internal Motor Heat)

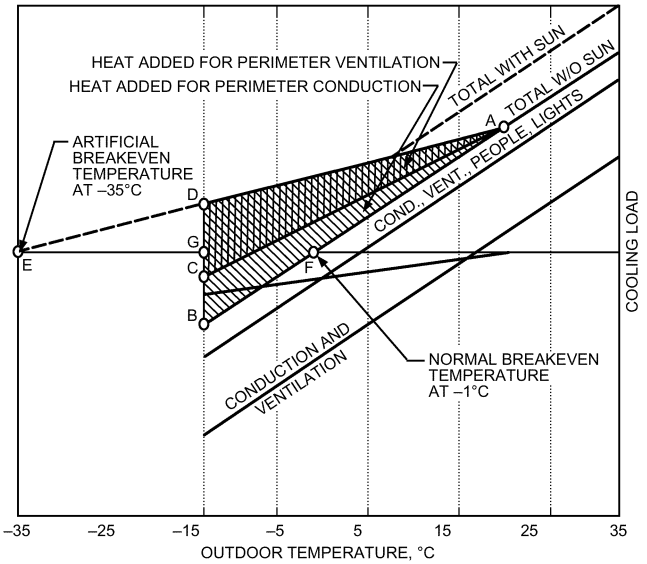


Fig. 36 Non-Heat-Recovery System

there will be an entirely different result. As the outdoor wet-bulb temperature drops below 13°C, each unit volume of air introduced does more cooling. To make matters more difficult, this increased cooling is latent cooling, which requires adding latent heat to prevent too low a relative humidity, yet this air is intended to cool. The extent of this added external heat for free cooling is shown to be very large when plotted on a heat balance analysis at –18°C outdoor temperature.

Figure 36 is typical for many current non-heat-recovery systems. There may be a need for cooling, even at the minimum design temperature, but the need to add external heat for humidification can be eliminated by using available internal heat. When this asset is thrown away and external heat is added, operation is inefficient.

Some systems recover heat from exhaust air to heat the incoming air. When a system operates below its natural break-even temperature t_{be} such as –1 or –9°C (shown in Figure 35), the heat recovered from exhaust air is useful and beneficial. This assumes that only the available internal heat is used and that no supplementary heat is added at or above t_{be}. Above t_{be}, the internal heat is sufficient and any recovered heat would become excessive heat to be removed by more outdoor air or refrigeration.

If heat is added to a central system to create an artificial t_{be} of –35°C as in Figure 36, any recovered heat above –35°C requires an equivalent amount of heat removal elsewhere. If the project were in an area with a minimum design temperature of –18°C, heat recovery from exhaust air could be a liability at all times for the conditions stipulated in Figure 35. This does not mean that the value of heat recovered from exhaust air should be forgotten. The emphasis should be on recovering heat from exhaust air rather than on adding external heat.

2. A heat balance shows that insulation, double glazing, and so forth can be extremely valuable on some projects. However, these practices may be undesirable in some regions during the heating season, when excess heat must usually be removed from large buildings. For instance, for minimum winter design temperatures of approximately 2 to 4°C, it is improbable that the interior core of a large office building will ever reach its break-even temperature. The temperature lag for shutdown periods, such as nights and weekends, at minimum design conditions could never economically justify the added cost of double-pane windows. Therefore, double-pane windows merely require the amount of heat saved to be removed elsewhere.

General Applications

A properly applied heat reclaim system automatically responds to make a balanced heat recovery. An example is a reciprocating water chiller with a hot-gas diverting valve and both a water-cooled and an air-cooled condenser. Hot gas from the compressor is rejected to the water-cooled condenser. This hot water provides internal heat as long as it is needed. At a predetermined temperature, the hot gas is diverted to the air-cooled condenser, rejecting excess heat from the total building system. Larger projects with centrifugal compressors use double-condenser chiller units, which are available from many manufacturers. For typical buildings, chillers normally provide hot water for space heating at 41 to 43°C.

Many buildings that run chillers all or most of the year reclaim some of the condenser heat to provide domestic hot water.

Designers should include a source of external heat for back-up. The control system should ensure that back-up heat is not injected unless all internal heat has been used. For example, if electric back-up coils are in series with hot-water coils fed from a hot-water storage tank, they may automatically start when the system restarts after the building temperature has dropped to a night low-limit setting. An adjustable time delay in the control circuit gives the stored hot water time to warm the building before energizing the electric heat.

This type of heat reclaim system is readily adaptable to smaller projects using a reciprocating chiller with numerous air terminal units or a common multizone air handler. The multizone air handler should have individual zone duct heating coils and controls arranged to prevent simultaneous heating and cooling in the same zone.

Properly applied heat reclaim systems not only meet all space heating needs, but also provide hot water required for showers, food service facilities, and reheat in conjunction with dehumidification cycles.

Heat reclaim chillers or heat pumps should not be used with air-handling systems that have modulating damper economizer control. This free cooling may result in a higher annual operating cost than a minimum fresh air system with a heat reclaim chiller. Careful study shows whether the economizer cycle violates the heat balance concept.

Heat reclaim chillers or heat pumps are available in many sizes and configurations. Combinations include (1) centrifugal, reciprocating, and screw compressors; (2) single- and double-bundle condensers; (3) cascade design for higher temperatures (up to 105°C); and (4) air- or water-cooled, or both.

The designer can make the best selection after both a heating and cooling load calculation and a preliminary economic analysis, and with an understanding of the building, processes, operating patterns, and available energy sources.

ASHRAE research project RP-620 (Cane et al. 1993) evaluated computer models for heat recovery chillers. Whole-building energy use predictions were 5 to 15% of actual monitored data for one building used in the evaluation. Heat recovery chiller estimates were within 10 to 15% of measured values in the same building.

Applications of heat reclaim chillers or heat pumps range from simple systems with few control modes to complex systems having many control modes and incorporating two- or four-pipe circulating systems. Some systems using double- and single-bundle condensers coupled with exterior closed-circuit coolers have been patented. Potential patent infringements should be checked early in the planning stage.

Successful heat recovery design depends on the performance of the total system, not just the chiller or heat pump. Careful, thorough

analysis is often time-consuming and requires more design time than a nonrecovery system. The balanced heat recovery concept should guide all phases of planning and design, and the effects of economic compromise should be studied. There may be little difference between the initial (installed) cost of a heat recovery system and a nonrecovery system, especially in larger projects. Also, in view of energy costs, life-cycle analysis usually shows dramatic savings when using balanced heat recovery.

Multiple Buildings

A multiple-building complex is particularly suited to heat recovery. Variations in occupancy and functions provide an abundance of heat sources and uses. Applying the balanced heat concept to a large multibuilding complex can save substantial energy. Each building captures its own total heat by interchange. Heat rejected from one building could possibly heat adjacent buildings.

3.4 HEAT PUMPS IN DISTRICT HEATING AND COOLING SYSTEMS

District heating (DH) and district cooling (DC) systems distribute thermal energy from a central source to residential, commercial, and/or industrial consumers for space heating and cooling, domestic hot-water heating, process heat, cooking, combustion turbine inlet air cooling, and humidification. Heat is normally distributed in the form of hot water or steam for district heating and chilled water for district cooling. Detailed planning and design guidance is available in Chapter 12, IDEA (2008), and Phetteplace et al. (2013a, 2013b).

This discussion is limited to systems that use heat pumps to generate heating and/or cooling at a central plant, as in the classic implementation of DH and DC and variations on this approach. More loosely defined DH or DC systems (e.g., a conventional district cooling plant that uses air- or water-cooled chillers could be seen as a heat pump system that extracts heat in producing below-ambient temperature chilled water, and rejects that heat at above-ambient temperatures) are not discussed; see ASHRAE (2012), IDEA (2008), and Phetteplace et al. (2013a, 2013b) for guidance on these sorts of systems.

District heating and cooling (DHC) offers the opportunity to take advantage of heating and cooling sources that would not be feasible or economical on an individual building plant basis. This is especially true when heat pumps are added to DHC systems, because they allow for use of heat sources/sinks that would otherwise be too low/high in temperature for direct use. DHC systems also offer the ability to take advantage of diversity of demand, and in some configurations are able to use reject heat (e.g., from a cooling process as a source for a heating process). Potential heat sources and sinks are

- Seawater (heating or cooling)
- Sewage, either treated or untreated (heating or cooling)
- Deep lake or ocean water (cooling)
- Industrial waste heat streams (heating or cooling)
- Low-temperature geothermal resources (heating)
- Ambient-temperature geothermal (heating or cooling)

Examples of DHC systems built around these heat sources/sinks can be found in Frederiksen and Werner (2013) and Phetteplace et al. (2013b). In some instances, the temperature of these potential heats sources and sinks is high (low) enough to be used directly for applications such as space heating (cooling), crop drying, aquaculture, etc. However, often they must serve as a heat source or sink for a heat pump system that will in turn serve the heating or cooling need. District scale heat pump systems as large as 120 MW are currently in use (Phetteplace et al. 2013b).

District-scale heat pump systems using central station heat pump(s) can generate useful heating and cooling effects simultaneously with the same heat pump unit(s). As essentially large-scale HRHPs, such systems can offer very favorable overall system COP. Some of these systems have been combined with ambient-temperature geothermal as a storage device: for example, Luster (2012) describes a system that uses several large geothermal bore fields in a campus district heating and district cooling system. This system is configured much like any district heating and/or cooling system, except that the heat source/sink is the a heat pump/chiller-based system, and the geothermal bore fields are used to meet unbalanced simultaneous heating/cooling demand. However, the heat supply temperature of a system using heat pumps as a heat source will be lower than in many district heating systems outside of northern Europe (Li et al. 2014; Zinko et al. 2008).

Other heat-pump-based DHC systems take an alternative approach in which the heat pumps are distributed in the system rather than at a central plant. Perry and Ren (2013) describe such a system that uses treated sewage effluent as the heat source/sink: this system uses the village's distribution system to supply water to heat pump systems at temperatures from 10 to 18°C, and has a back-up heat supply of a central plant fueled with natural gas.

In district cooling systems, achieving high ΔT between supply and return water is always a design objective (Phetteplace et al. 2013a). However, many systems fail to meet that objective, so much so that in the industry the problem has been described as **low ΔT syndrome**. As described by Phetteplace et al. (2013a) the problem emanates from the in-building equipment and often is difficult to correct if proper design for district cooling has not been used within the building. While not a solution for this fundamental problem that creates low ΔT, a district cooling system could improve its ΔT by using heat pumps within buildings that would further increase the return temperature by discarding heat into the return line. These heat pumps could either be used in buildings that already use the district cooling system in a conventional manner, or in buildings only connected to the district cooling system return line. While the use of essentially two chillers/heat pumps in series for space cooling might seem inefficient, the in-building heat pump would be operating at a very high COP, because its sink for heat rejection, the district cooling return water, is at a very favorable temperature for the heat pump to reject heat. Furthermore, at the central chiller plant of the district cooling system the chiller will likely be the more efficient water-cooled type, and incremental heat removal at the chiller's input temperature (chilled-water return from district distribution system) is more efficient than at the average supply and return temperature at which the chiller operates overall. Where the in-building heat pump is in heating mode and is removing heat from the district chilled water return line, this is heat that will not have to be removed at the chiller plant.

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CHAPTER 10

SMALL FORCED-AIR HEATING AND COOLING SYSTEMS

Components 10.1
Common System Problems 10.2
System Design 10.3
Detailed Duct Design 10.5
Small Commercial Systems 10.9
Testing for Duct Efficiency 10.10

THIS chapter describes the basics of design and component selection of small forced-air heating and cooling systems, explains their importance, and describes the system's parametric effects on energy consumption. It also gives an overview of test methods for thermal distribution system efficiency, and considers the interaction between the building thermal/pressure envelope and the forced-air heating and cooling system, which is critical to the energy efficiency and cost effectiveness of the overall system. This chapter pertains to residential and certain small commercial systems; large commercial systems are beyond the scope of this chapter. Applicable standards are listed in the Standards section at the end of the chapter.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.3, Central Forced Air Heating and Cooling Systems.

1. COMPONENTS

Forced-air systems are heating and/or cooling systems that use motor-driven blowers to distribute heated, cooled, and otherwise treated air to multiple outlets for the comfort of individuals in confined spaces. A typical residential or small commercial system includes (1) a heating and/or cooling unit, (2) supply and return ductwork (including registers and grilles), (3) accessory equipment, and (4) controls. These components are described briefly in the following sections and example locations are shown in Figure 1. Other possible locations for equipment include basements, attics, indoor or outdoor closets, garages, or outdoors (on the ground, a platform, or the roof of the building).

Fig. 1 Heating and Cooling Components

(*Source*: www.energystar/gov/newhomes/explore_features_benefits/heating_cooling)

Heating and Cooling Units

Three types of forced-air heating and cooling devices are (1) furnaces, (2) air conditioners, and (3) heat pumps.

Furnaces are the basic component of most forced-air heating systems (see Chapter 33). They are manufactured to use specific fuels such as oil, natural gas, or liquefied petroleum gas, and are augmented with an air-conditioning coil when cooling is included. The fuel used dictates installation requirements and safety considerations.

Common **air-conditioning** systems use a split configuration with an air-handling unit, such as a furnace. The air-conditioning evaporator coil (indoor unit) is installed on the discharge air side of the air handler. The compressor and condensing coil (outdoor unit) are located outside the structure, and refrigerant lines connect the outdoor and indoor units.

Packaged self-contained air conditioners contain all necessary air-conditioning components, including circulating air blowers, condenser coils, compressors, evaporator coils, etc. These systems may or may not include fuel-fired heat exchangers or electric heating elements.

Heat pumps cool and heat using the refrigeration cycle. They are available in split and packaged (self-contained) configurations. Generally, air-source heat pumps require supplemental heating, so electric heating elements are usually included with the heat pump as part of the forced-air system. Heat pumps offer high efficiency at mild temperatures, but may be combined with fossil-fuel furnaces to minimize heating cost. Heat pump supplemental heating also may be provided by thermostat-controlled gas heating appliances (e.g., fireplaces, free-standing stoves). As focus on decarbonization increases, heat pumps will play an important role in heating buildings.

Ground-source heat pumps (GSHPs) are becoming more common in residential housing, especially in colder climates. Because underground temperatures are mild year-round, GSHPs typically do not use supplemental heating except in emergency mode (i.e., when the heat pump does not provide enough heat).

Ducts

Ducts convey air to and from the fan in a heating or cooling unit. Registers and grilles are perforated covers over the openings where ductwork meets room walls, ceilings, or floors. In the extreme, a single return grille may connect directly to the fan cabinet. Supply registers often allow control of flow volume and direction. Dampers act as adjustable valves to control flow volume; turning vanes help redirect the flow around sharp bends. Duct systems can have very significant impacts on system efficiency and occupant comfort, and should be carefully designed, not just constructed by rules of thumb.

Accessory Equipment

Forced-air systems may be equipped with accessories that further condition the air. They may modify humidity, remove contaminants, mix outdoor air with the recirculating air, or transfer energy in other ways. Disposable air filters on the return side of forced-air systems are so common that they are not considered accessories.

Humidifiers. Humidifiers add moisture to the airstream directly as steam or an atomized spray, or by evaporation from heated pans or porous media. Chapter 22 of this volume contains more information on humidifiers.

Dehumidifiers. Dehumidifiers remove moisture from the airstream, typically by cooling it below the condensation point. Some self-contained equipment may have dehumidification integrated into the system. Also see the section on Dehumidifiers in Chapter 1 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Electronic Air Cleaners. Far more effective than the passive filters normally found in forced-air systems, these units use static electricity to capture fine dust, smoke, and other particles. Electronic air cleaners usually have a washable prefilter to trap lint and larger particles as they enter the unit. The remaining particles take on an electric charge in a charging section, then travel to the collector section where they are drawn to and trapped on the oppositely charged collecting plates. These plates must be washed periodically. See Chapter 29 for more information on air cleaners.

Ultraviolet Lamp Sterilizers. Short-wavelength ultraviolet lamps in the fan cabinet can kill organisms in the circulating air and may prevent mold build-up on the wet cooling coil. See Chapter 17 for details.

Energy/Heat Recovery Ventilators. These devices provide ventilation air to the conditioned space and recover energy/heat from the air being exhausted outdoors. They can be operated as stand-alone devices or as part of the forced-air distribution system. See Chapter 26 for more information about energy/heat recovery ventilators.

Economizer Controls. These devices monitor outdoor temperature and humidity and automatically shut down the air-conditioning unit when a preset outdoor condition is met. Damper motors open outdoor return air dampers, letting outdoor air enter the system to provide comfort cooling. When outdoor air conditions are no longer acceptable, the outdoor air dampers close and the air-conditioning unit comes back on.

Custom Accessories. Solar collectors, off-peak storage, and other custom systems are not covered in this chapter. However, their components may be classified as system accessories.

Controls

A simple thermostat controlling on/off cycling of central equipment may be all that is used or needed for temperature control. Such thermostats typically have a switch for automatic or continuous fan operation, and another to choose heating, cooling, or neither.

More complex systems may provide control features for timed variations (from simple night setback to a weekly schedule of temperatures); multiple independent zones, power stages, or fan speeds; influence of outdoor sensors; humidity; automatic switching between heating and cooling modes, etc. (see Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*). Energy conservation has increased the importance of control, so methods that once were considered too expensive for small systems may now be cost-effective.

2. COMMON SYSTEM PROBLEMS

One of the most common problems is an **oversized cooling system** that does not need to run very long to cool the air, so it does not have time to remove much moisture. High humidity is uncomfortable, and also can encourage mold growth.

Too-small ducts create high resistance to airflow that can cause excess power consumption, high pressures, and low flow rates, especially if combined with an oversized system. High pressures can increase noise from airflow and from the fan itself, and can make it difficult to balance the system for appropriate distribution to all rooms. Low flow rates can result in ice formation on the cooling coil (possibly shutting off flow completely) and even on refrigerant piping; when that ice eventually melts, water can enter places that should stay dry. **Long ducts** running to perimeter walls not only increase resistance, but often run through unconditioned space where they can be exposed to extreme temperatures. **Leaky ducts** are common. Cummings et al. (2003) tested air leakage in 30 air-handler cabinets and at connections to supply and return ductwork; leakage rates averaged 6.3% of overall system airflow. Leaks not only reduce efficiency, but can also draw in humidity, dust, pollen, etc. Leaks also can allow relatively humid indoor air to leak out to cold surfaces where the water can condense, causing staining, mold, rot, and other problems. In cold climates, an air leak in the attic can

result in ice formation and the potential for significant damage. A potential solution is to install ducts in a conditioned space, but this is not always practical.

Poor installation practices primarily affect duct systems, but condensate removal also can be a problem area. Air leakage problems as described previously come from failure to seal properly all openings in an air-handling cabinet, joints in the duct system, joints where ducts meet register flares, and openings where register flares penetrate the room. Crude duct-taped joints sometimes come apart after a few years. Flexible ductwork is easy to install, but is also easy to install sloppily, with kinks and unnecessary bends that restrict flow.

Cooling systems installed above ground level commonly have a gravity drain for condensate, and a catch pan under the unit as a backup, with its own gravity drain. Manufacturers specify the allowable variance from level for the installed system. If the main condensate drain runs uphill, the problem becomes evident almost immediately. If the problem is with the catch pan drain, it may be years before a major freeze-up generates enough water to overflow the pan and cause significant damage. Over time, mold and dirt can build up enough to block a drain line. Periodic cleaning may be necessary.

Dirty filters occur when homeowners neglect to clean or replace them. This may be from a lack of homeowner education or from the filters not being readily accessible (e.g., if the air handler filter rack is in the attic). They are not merely an air cleanliness problem; they can cut down airflow enough to raise circulating blower power use and even cause cooling coils to freeze up.

Air-source heat pumps in colder climates typically are equipped with auxiliary electric heat strips. Since resistance heating normally is much less efficient than a heat pump, less-sophisticated control systems can result in **unnecessary electric resistance heating** and higher electric bills. The resistance heating is necessary when continuous operation of the heat pump is insufficient to maintain indoor temperature; however, it may also come on when the thermostat setting is raised (manually, or automatically after night setback). Control systems may turn on resistance heating each time the system is reversed to defrost the outdoor coil, to prevent indoor cold blow.

This is by no means an exhaustive list of the types of problems to watch out for in forced air heating and cooling systems, but it should alert designers to some of the most common ones.

3. SYSTEM DESIGN

The size and performance characteristics of components are interrelated, and the overall design should proceed in the organized manner described. For example, furnace selection depends on heat gain and loss and is also affected by duct location (attic, basement, etc.), duct materials, night setback, and humidifier use. Here is a recommended procedure:

1. Estimate heating and cooling loads, including target values for ventilation and duct losses.
2. Determine preliminary ductwork location and materials of ductwork and outlets.
3. Determine heating and cooling unit location.
4. Select accessory equipment. Accessory equipment is not generally provided with initial construction; however, the system may be designed for later addition of these components.
5. Select control components.
6. Select heating/cooling equipment.
7. Determine maximum airflow (cooling or heating) for each supply and return location.
8. Determine airflow at reduced heating and cooling loads (two-speed and variable-speed fans).
9. Finalize heating/cooling equipment.
10. Finalize control system.
11. Finalize duct design and size.
12. Select supply and return grilles.
13. When the duct system is in place, measure duct leakage and compare results with target values used in step 1.

This procedure requires certain preliminary information such as location, weather conditions, and architectural considerations. The following sections cover the preliminary considerations and discuss how to follow this recommended procedure.

Estimating Heating and Cooling Loads

Design heating and cooling loads can be calculated by following the procedures outlined in Chapters 17, 18, and 19 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* When calculating design loads, heat losses or gains from the air distribution system must be included in the total load for each room. In residential and commercial applications, local codes often require outdoor air ventilation, which is added to the building load. Target values for duct losses may be set by codes, voluntary programs, or other recommendations. If ducts are located in the conditioned space, losses can be reduced essentially to zero. If this is not possible, losses should be limited to 10% of the heating or cooling load.

Locating Outlets, Returns, Ducts, and Equipment

The characteristics of a residence determine the appropriate type of forced-air system and where it can be installed. The presence or absence of particular areas in a residence directly influences equipment and duct location. The structure's size, room or area use, and air-distribution system determine how many central systems will be needed to maintain comfort temperatures in all areas.

For maximum energy efficiency, ductwork and equipment should be installed in the conditioned space. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.2 gives a credit for installation in this location. The next best location is in a full basement. If a residence has an insulated, unvented, and sealed crawlspace, the ductwork and equipment can be located there (with appropriate provision for combustion air, if applicable), or the equipment can be placed in a closet or utility room. Vented attics and vented crawlspaces are the least preferred locations for ductwork and HVAC equipment. The equipment's enclosure must meet all fire and safety code requirements; adequate service clearance must also be provided. In a home built on a concrete slab, equipment could be located in the conditioned space (for systems that do not require combustion air), in an unconditioned closet, in an attached garage, in the attic space, or outdoors. Ductwork normally is located in a furred space, in the slab, or in the attic.

Duct construction must conform to local code requirements, which often reference NFPA *Standard* 90B or the *Residential Comfort System Installation Standards Manual* (SMACNA 2016).

Weather should be considered when locating equipment and ductwork. All equipment must be installed per the manufacturer's instructions. Packaged outdoor units should be carefully considered for houses in extreme cold or hot climates. Most houses in cold climates have basements, making them well suited for indoor furnaces and split-system air conditioners or heat pumps. In mild and moderate climates, ductwork frequently is located in the attic or crawlspace, but the conditioned space still is best.

Locating and Selecting Outlets and Returns. Although the principles of air distribution discussed in Chapter 20 of this volume and Chapter 20 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* apply in forced-air system design, simplified methods of selecting outlet size and location generally are used.

Supply outlets fall into four general groups, defined by their air discharge patterns: (1) horizontal high, (2) vertical nonspreading, (3) vertical spreading, and (4) horizontal low. Straub and Chen (1957) and Wright et al. (1963) describe these types and their performance characteristics under controlled laboratory and actual res-

Table 1 General Characteristics of Supply Outlets

Group	Outlet Type	Outlet Flow Pattern	Conditioning Mode	Most Effective Application	Selection Criteria
1	Ceiling and high sidewall	Horizontal	Cooling	*Ceiling outlets*	
				Full-circle or widespread type	Select for throw equal to distance from outlet to nearest wall at design flow rate and pressure limitations.
				Narrow spread type	Select for throw equal to 0.75 to 1.2 times distance from outlet to nearest wall at design flow rate and pressure limitations.
				Two adjacent ceiling outlets	Select each so that throw is about 0.5 times distance between them at design flow rate and pressure limits.
				High sidewall outlets	Select for throw equal to 0.75 to 1.2 times distance to nearest wall at design flow rate and pressure limits. If pressure drop is excessive, use several smaller outlets rather than one large one to reduce pressure drop.
2	Floor diffusers, baseboard, and low sidewall	Vertical, nonspreading	Cooling and heating		Select for 1.8 to 2.4 m throw at design flow rate and pressure limitations.
3	Floor diffusers, baseboard, and low sidewall	Vertical, spreading	Heating and cooling		Select for 1.2 to 1.8 m throw at design flow rate and pressure limitations.
4	Baseboard, and low sidewall	Horizontal	Heating only		Limit face velocity to 1.5 m/s.

idence conditions. Table 1 lists the general characteristics of supply outlets. It includes the performance of various outlet types for cooling as well as heating, because one of the advantages of forced-air systems is that they may be used for both heating and cooling. However, as indicated in Table 1, no single outlet type is best for both heating and cooling.

The best outlets for heating traditionally have been located near the floor at outer walls and provide a vertical spreading air jet, preferably under windows, to blanket cold areas and counteract cold drafts. Called **perimeter heating**, this arrangement mixes warm supply air with both cool air from the area of high heat loss and cold air from infiltration, preventing drafts. In newer, more energy-efficient homes having well-insulated envelopes with low air leakage rates, it is no longer necessary to locate outlets near exterior walls. Instead, locating outlets as close as possible to the heating/cooling equipment allows for shorter duct runs, reducing duct leakage and pressure losses. This is especially important if it is not possible to locate the ducts in the conditioned space. See the section on Detailing the Duct Configuration for further information.

If outlets are located on the floor or low on the wall, avoid locations likely to be blocked by furnishings or opened doors.

The best outlet types for cooling are located in the ceiling and have a horizontal air discharge pattern. For year-round systems, supply outlets are located to satisfy the more critical load.

The stagnant layer develops near the floor during heating and near the ceiling during cooling. Returns help remove air from this region if the return face is placed in the stagnant zone. Thus, for heating, returns should be placed low; for cooling, returns should be placed high. However, in a year-round heating and cooling application, a compromise must be made by placing returns where the largest stagnant zone develops. With low supply outlets, the largest stagnant zone develops during cooling, so returns should be placed high or opposite the supply locations. Conversely, high supply outlets do not perform as well during heating; therefore, returns should be placed low to be of maximum benefit.

If central return is used, the airflow between supply registers and the return should not be impeded even when interior doors are closed. This can be accomplished by undercutting doors or by providing alternative paths such as louvers or crossover ducts.

Selecting Heating and Cooling Equipment

Furnace heating output should match or slightly exceed the estimated design load. The Air Conditioning Contractors of America (ACCA *Manual* S) recommends a 40% limit on oversizing for fossil-fuel furnaces. This limit minimizes venting problems associated with oversized equipment and improves part-load performance. Note that the calculated load must include duct loss, humidification load, and night setback recovery load, as well as building conduction and infiltration heat losses. Chapter 33 has detailed information on how to size and select a furnace.

To help conserve energy, manufacturers have added features to improve furnace efficiency. Electric ignition has replaced the standing pilot; vent dampers and more efficient motors are also available. Furnaces with fan-assisted combustion systems (FACSs) and condensing furnaces also improve efficiency. Two-stage heating and cooling, variable-speed heat pumps, and two-speed and variable-speed blowers are also available.

Research on the effect of blower performance on residential forced-air heating system performance suggested reductions of 650 to 900 MJ/yr for automatic furnace fan operation and 9360 MJ/yr for continuous fan operation by changing from permanent split capacitor (PSC) blower motors to brushless permanent electronically commutated magnet motors (ECMs) (Phillips 1998). Consequently, DOE fan efficiency regulation has led to nearly all air-handling equipment currently in production using the more efficient ECM blower motors.

A system designed to both heat and cool and that cycles cooling equipment on and off by sensing dry-bulb temperature alone should be sized to match the design heat gain as closely as possible. Oversizing under this control strategy could lead to higher-than-desired indoor humidity levels. Chapter 17 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* recommends that cooling units not be oversized. Other sources suggest limiting oversizing to 15% of the sensible load. A heat pump should be sized for the cooling load with supplemental heat provided to meet heating requirements. Size air-source heat pumps in accordance with the equipment manufacturer recommendations. ACCA *Manual* S can also be used to assist in the selection and sizing of equipment.

Determining Airflow Requirements

After equipment is selected and before duct design,

1. Determine air quantities required for each room or space during heating and cooling based on each room's heat loss or heat gain. The air quantity selected should be the greater of the heating or cooling requirement.
2. Determine number of supply outlets needed for each space to supply the selected air quantity, considering discharge velocity, spread, throw, terminal velocity, occupancy patterns, location of heat gain and loss sources, and register or diffuser design.
3. Determine type of return (multiple or central), availability of space for grilles, filtering, maximum velocity limits for sound, efficient filtration velocity, and space use limitations.

Finalize Duct Design and Size

Duct design too often is ignored in residences, and simply is left to a contractor to install in the traditional way. Because of the significant effect ducts can have on system efficiency, this topic is discussed extensively here.

Selecting Supply and Return Grilles and Registers

Grilles and registers are selected from a manufacturer's catalog with appropriate engineering data after the duct design is completed. Avoid rule-of-thumb selection. Carefully determine the suitability of the register or grille selected for each location according to its performance specification for the quantity of air to be delivered and the discharge velocity from the duct.

Generally, in small commercial and residential applications, selection and application of registers and grilles is particularly important because system size and air-handling capacity are small in energy-efficient structures. Proper selection ensures satisfactory delivery of heating and/or cooling. Table 1 summarizes selection criteria for common types of supply outlets. Pressure loss is usually limited to 7.5 Pa or less.

Return grilles are usually sized to provide an exit velocity at their face of 2 to 3 m/s, or 0.002 to 0.003 L/s per square millimetre of free area. Some central return grilles are designed to hold an air filter. This design allows the air to be filtered close to the occupied area and also allows easy access for filter maintenance. Easy access is important when the furnace is in a remote area such as a crawlspace or attic. The air velocity through a filter grille should not exceed 1.5 m/s, which means that the volume of air should not exceed 0.0015 L/s per square millimetre of free filter area. Free area may range from 30 to 70% of total grille area.

4. DETAILED DUCT DESIGN

Detailing the Duct Configuration

The next major decision is to select a generic duct system. In order of decreasing efficiency, the three main types are

1. Ducts in conditioned space
2. Minimum-area ductwork (minimum run length results in minimum surface area)
3. Traditional designs

Ductwork costs and system energy use can be reduced when the home designer/architect, builder, subcontractors, and HVAC installer collaborate to place **ducts in conditioned spaces** and minimize duct runs. Residential duct systems in unconditioned spaces can lose a significant percent of the energy in the air they distribute. These losses can be almost entirely eliminated simply by locating ducts in the conditioned space (insulated building envelope), which is a cost-effective way to increase heating and cooling equipment efficiency and lower utility bills (Modera 1989). Benefits include improved comfort, improved indoor air quality, and lower utility bills and equipment cost.

Any losses (air or conductive) from ducts in conditioned space still provide space conditioning. Ducts in conditioned space are also subjected to much less severe conditions, reducing conductive losses and the effect of return air leaks. Several approaches can be used to accomplish this:

- Trunks and branches can be located between floors of a two-story residence or along the wall-ceiling intersections in a single-story dwelling. Care must be taken to seal the rim joist between floors, and/or the wall-to-ceiling intersection.
- In some houses, the ceiling in a central hallway can be lowered. The air barrier is still provided at the higher level, bringing the space between the ceiling and air barrier into conditioned space. Ducts are installed in this space, with supply registers located on the walls of adjacent spaces. The ceiling can be dropped in closets, bathrooms, or, if necessary, a soffit to get ducts to rooms that are not adjacent to the central hallway. Figures 2A and 2B illustrate the planning required for locating ductwork between floors in a two-story residence and in a townhouse.
- A slab-on-grade foundation is common in mild or moderate climates. With this type of foundation, supply air ducts are typically located in the attic. During the winter, attic air temperatures tend to match outdoor air temperatures. During the summer, solar heat gains can raise attic air temperatures over 65°C. These temperature extremes increase heat losses and gains from conduction and radiation and decrease duct efficiency. In addition, any conditioned air that leaks out of the duct is lost into the attic. If return ducts also are in the attic, return leaks pull unconditioned air into the system (particularly detrimental in hot, humid climates).
- Figures 3A, 3B, and 3C show a ceiling plenum in the hallway that allows ducts to be located in the conditioned space. Air temperatures in this location are typically between 13 and 30°C, which minimizes conduction and radiation losses. Air that leaks out of the ducts goes into the conditioned space.
- Attics can be included in the conditioned space by relocating the thermal barrier to the roof and eliminating ridge and soffit vents to provide an air barrier at the roof line. Insulation can be installed at the roofline by, for example, installing netting material between trusses, and installing blown-in cellulose insulation. Ductwork

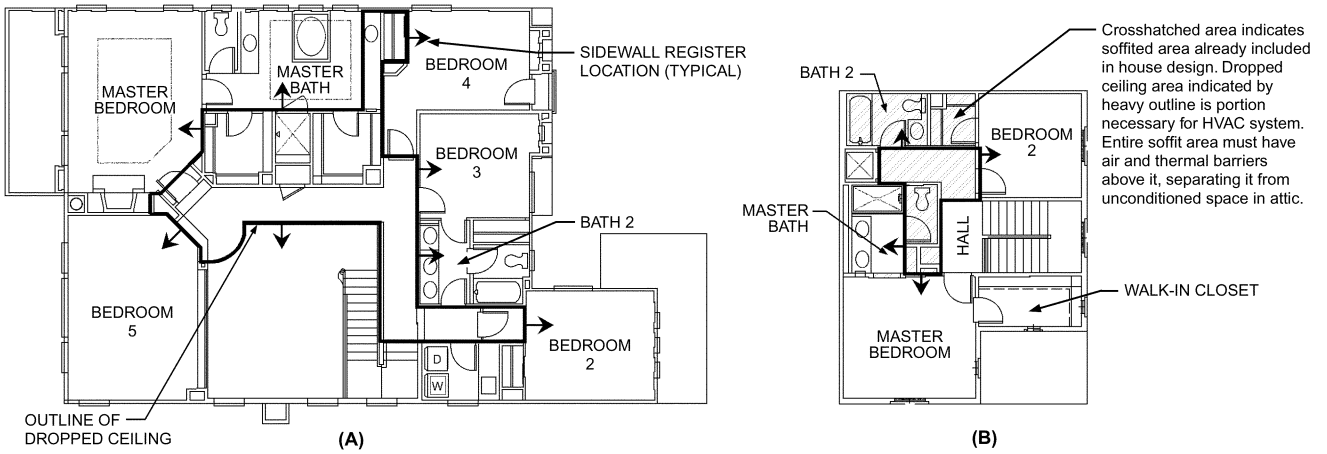

Fig. 2 Sample Floor Plans for Locating Ductwork in Second Floor of (A) Two-Story House and (B) Townhouse

(Hedrick 2002)

can then be installed in the attic in conditioned space. In cold climates, care must be taken to avoid condensation on the inside of the roof deck; in hot climates, the lack of roof venting may argue against using asphalt-shingle roofing. One roofing option is a composite board consisting of thick, rigid foam insulation, vertically aligned spacing strips, and a solid plywood upper layer, fastened with very long screws onto the roof trusses. The spacing strips allow airflow under the main deck (but above the insulation) from soffits to ridge vents. It is important that no gaps be left between the insulation slabs of adjacent boards.

- A plenum space can be created in the attic by using roof trusses that do not have a traditional flat bottom chord. A modified scissors truss design, which provides space between the bottom chord of the truss and the top chord of the wall framing, provides a duct space that can be brought into conditioned space. The bottom chord of the trusses is used to install an air barrier, with insulation blown in on top. Ductwork is installed in the plenum space, with supply registers located near interior walls (because the space may not extend all the way to the exterior walls).

  It is important that the ducts be located inside thermal and air barriers, and that the air barrier be well sealed to minimize air communication with the outdoors. The duct space is rarely completely in conditioned space (other than in exposed ductwork systems). When there is an air barrier between the ducts and the occupied space, some fraction of air and thermal losses from the duct system goes to the outdoors rather than to the occupied space. High-quality air sealing on the exterior air barrier minimizes these losses to the outdoors.

Many new buildings have well-insulated envelopes or sufficient thermal integrity so that supply registers do not have to be located next to exterior walls. Placing registers in interior walls can reduce duct surface area by 50% or more, with similar reductions in leakage and conductive losses. This option also offers significant first-cost savings. **Minimum-area ductwork systems** are used in most houses built with ducts in conditioned space, including those using a dropped ceiling.

Figures 2 and 3 show improved duct designs for new energy-efficient residential construction. These residences are designed with tighter envelopes/ducts, increased insulation, and high-performance windows, resulting in wall, window, floor, and ceiling temperatures that are warmer in winter and cooler in summer, and are more comfortable and less drafty.

In **traditional designs** for standard residential construction, supply ducts are typically run in unconditioned spaces, with supplies located near the perimeter of a house to offset drafts from cold exterior surfaces, especially windows. (Compare Figures 4A and 4B with 3B and 3C). Because this is the least efficient option overall, take particular care to seal and insulate the ductwork. Any air leaks on the supply side of the system allow conditioned supply air to escape to the outdoors. Return-side leaks draw air at extreme temperatures into the system instead of tempered room air. Return leaks can also have indoor air quality effects if the return ducts are located in garages or other spaces where contaminants may be present. In humid climates, return leaks bringing in humid outdoor air can raise the humidity in the space, increasing the risk of mold and mildew.

Detailing the Distribution Design

The major goal in duct design is to provide proper air distribution throughout a residence. To achieve this in an energy-efficient manner, ducts must be sized and laid out to facilitate airflow and minimize friction, turbulence, and heat loss and gain. The optimal air

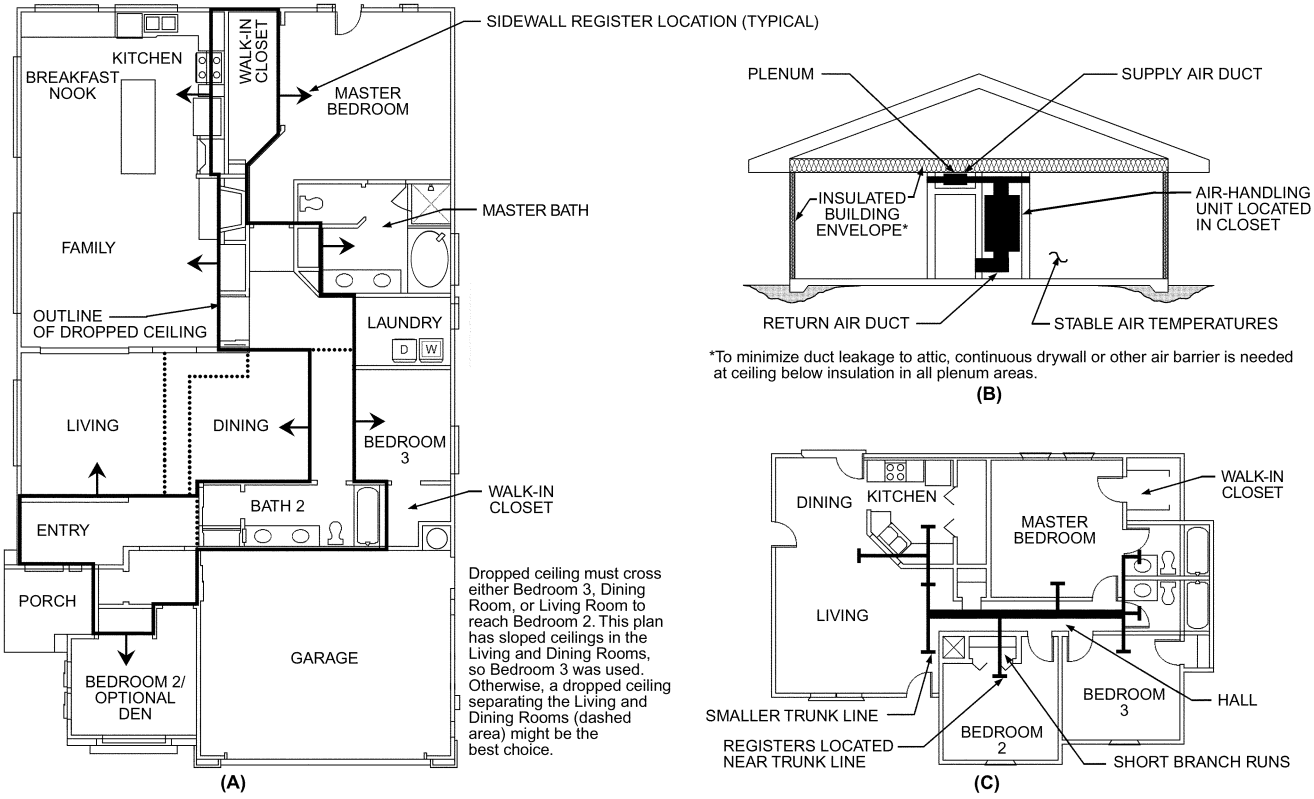

Fig. 3 Sample Floor Plans for One-Story House with (A) Dropped Ceilings, (B) Ducts in Conditioned Spaces, and (C) Right-Sized Air Distribution in Conditioned Spaces

(EPA 2000)

distribution system has "right-sized" ducts, minimal runs, the smoothest interior surfaces possible, and the fewest possible direction and size changes. Figure 3C provides an example of right-sized ducts design.

The required airflow and the blower's static pressure limitation are the parameters around which the duct system is designed. The heat loss or gain for each space determines the proportion of the total airflow supplied to each space. Static pressure drop in supply registers should be limited to about 7.5 Pa. The required pressure drop must be deducted from the static pressure available for duct design.

The flow delivered by a single supply outlet should be determined by considering the (1) space limitations on the number of registers that can be installed, (2) pressure drop for the register at the flow rate selected, (3) adequacy of air delivery patterns for offsetting heat loss or gain, and (4) space use pattern.

Manufacturers' specifications include blower airflow for each blower speed and external static pressure combination. Determining static pressure available for duct design should include the possibility of adding accessories in the future (e.g., electronic air cleaners or humidifiers). Therefore, the highest available fan speed should not be used for design.

For systems that heat only, the blower rate may be determined from the manufacturer's data. The temperature rise of air passing through the heat exchanger of a fossil-fuel furnace must be within the manufacturer's recommended range (usually 22 to 45 K). The possible later addition of cooling should also be considered by selecting a blower that operates in the midrange of the fan speed and settings.

For cooling only, or for heating and cooling, the design flow can be estimated by the following equation:

$$Q = \frac{q_s}{\rho c_p \Delta t} \quad (1)$$

where

Q = flow rate, L/s
q_s = sensible load, W
ρ = air density assumed to equal 1.20 kg/m^3
c_p = specific heat of air = 1.0 kJ/(kg·K)
Δt = dry-bulb temperature difference between air entering and leaving equipment, K

Replacing all constant values gives the simplified equation in the given units.

$$Q = \frac{1}{1.2} \times \frac{q_s}{\Delta t} = \frac{q_s}{1.2 \Delta t} \quad (2)$$

For preliminary design, an approximate Δt is as follows:

Sensible Heat Ratio (SHR)	Δt, K
0.75 to 0.79	11.5
0.80 to 0.85	10.5
0.85 to 0.90	9.5

SHR = Calculated sensible load/Calculated total load

For example, if calculation indicates the sensible load is 6800 W and the latent load is 1500 W, the SHR is calculated as follows:

$$\text{SHR} = \frac{6800}{6800 + 1500} = 0.82$$

and

$$Q = \frac{6800}{1.2 + 10.5} = 540 \text{ L/s}$$

This value is the estimated design flow. The exact design flow can only be determined after the cooling unit is selected. The unit that is ultimately selected should supply an airflow in the range of the estimated flow, and must also have adequate sensible and latent cooling capacity when operating at design conditions.

Duct Design Recommendations

Residential construction duct design should be approached using duct calculators and the friction chart (see Figure 9 in Chapter 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). Chapters 8 and 9 of the ACCA Residential Duct System *Manual* D provide step-by-step duct sizing calculation examples and worksheets. Hand calculators and computer programs simplify the calculations required.

The ductwork distributes air to spaces according to the space heating and/or cooling requirements. The return air system may be single, multiple, or any combination that returns air to the equipment within design static pressure and with satisfactory air movement patterns (Table 2).

Some general rules in duct design are as follows:

- Keep main ducts as straight as possible.
- If plenums do not go straight into the air handler, include turning vanes at supply and return plenums.
- Streamline transitions.
- Design elbows with an inside radius of at least one-third the duct width. If this inside radius is not possible, include turning vanes.
- Seal ducts to limit air leakage.
- Insulate and/or line ducts, where necessary, to conserve energy and limit noise.
- Locate branch duct takeoffs at least 1200 mm downstream from a fan or transition, if possible.
- Include dampers in branch ducts to enable system balancing.
- Isolate air-moving equipment from the duct using flexible connectors to isolate noise.

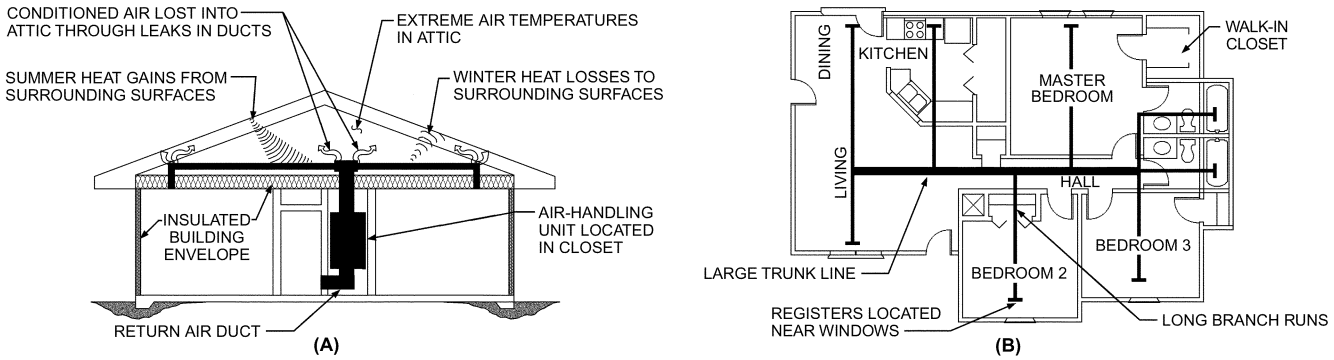

Fig. 4 (A) Ducts in Unconditioned Spaces and (B) Standard Air Distribution System in Unconditioned Spaces

(EPA 2000)

Large air distribution systems are designed to meet specific noise criteria (NC) levels. Small systems should also be designed to meet appropriate NC levels; however, acceptable duct noise levels can often be achieved by limiting air velocities in mains and branches to the following:

Main ducts	3.6 to 4.6 m/s
Branch ducts	3.0 m/s
Branch risers	2.5 m/s

Considerable difference may exist between the cooling and heating flow requirements. Because many systems cannot (or will not) be rebalanced seasonally, a compromise must be made in the duct design to accommodate the most critical need. For example, a kitchen may require 80 L/s for cooling but only 30 L/s for heating. Because the kitchen may be used heavily during design cooling periods, the cooling flow rate should be used. Normally, the maximum design flow should be used, as register dampers do allow some optional reduction in airflows.

Zone Control for Small Systems

In residential applications, some complaints about rooms that are too cold or too hot are related to the system's limitations. No matter how carefully a single-zone system is designed, problems occur if the control is unable to accommodate the various load conditions that occur simultaneously throughout the house at any time of day and/or during any season.

Single-zone control works as long as the various rooms are open to each other. In this case, room-to-room temperature differences are minimized by convection currents between the rooms. For small rooms, an open door is adequate. For large rooms, openings in partitions should be large enough to ensure adequate air interchange for single-zone control.

When rooms are isolated from each other, temperature differences cannot be moderated by convection currents, and conditions in the room with the thermostat may not be representative of conditions in the other rooms. In this situation, comfort can be improved by continuous blower operation, but this strategy reduces efficiency and may not completely solve the problem.

Zone control is required (or at least desired) when conditions at the thermostat are not representative of all the rooms. This situation will almost certainly occur if any of the following conditions exist:

- House has more than one level
- One or more rooms are used for entertaining large groups
- One or more rooms have large glass areas
- House has an indoor swimming pool and/or hot tub
- House has a solarium or atrium

In addition, zoning may be required when several rooms are isolated from each other and from the thermostat. This situation is likely to occur when

- House spreads out in many directions (wings)
- Some rooms are distinctly isolated from rest of house
- Envelope only has one or two exposures
- House has a room or rooms in a finished basement or attic
- House has one or more rooms with slab or exposed floor

Zone control can be achieved by installing

- Discrete heating/cooling ducts for each zone requiring control
- Automatic zone damper in a single heating/cooling duct system

The rate of airflow delivered to each room must be able to offset the peak room load during cooling. The peak room load can be determined using Chapter 17 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. The same supply air temperature difference used to size equipment can be substituted into Equation (1) to find airflow. The design flow rate for any zone is equal to the sum of the peak flow rates of all rooms assigned to a zone.

Table 2 Recommended Division of Duct Pressure Loss

System Characteristics	Supply, %	Return, %
A Single return at blower	90	10
B Single return at or near equipment	80	20
C Single return with appreciable return duct run	70	30
D Multiple return with moderate return duct system	60	40
E Multiple return with extensive return duct system	50	50

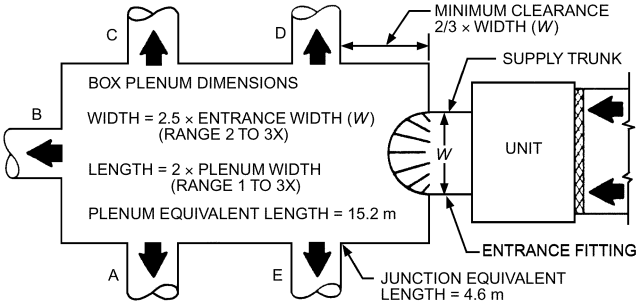

Fig. 6 Dimensions for Efficient Box Plenum

Duct Sizing for Zone Damper Systems

The following guidelines are proposed in ACCA *Manual* Zr, Appendix 9, to size various duct runs.

1. Use the design blower airflow rate to size a plenum or a main trunk that feeds the zone trunks. Size plenum and main trunk ducts at 4 m/s.
2. Use zone airflow rates (those based on the sum of the peak room loads) to size the zone trunk ducts. Size all zone trunks at 4 m/s.
3. Use the peak room airflow rate (those based on the peak room loads) to size the branch ducts or runouts. Size all branch runouts at a friction rate of 0.8 Pa/m. For commercial systems, use 0.65 Pa/m.
4. Size return ducts for 3 m/s air velocity.

Box Plenum Systems Using Flexible Duct

In some climates, an overhead duct with a box plenum feeding a series of individual, flexible-duct, branch runouts is popular. The pressure drop through a flexible duct is higher than through a rigid sheet metal duct, however. Recognizing this larger loss is important when designing a box plenum/flexible duct system.

Design of the box plenum is critical to avoid excessive pressure loss and to minimize unstable air rotation in the plenum, which can change direction between blower cycles. This in turn may change air delivery through individual branch takeoffs. Unstable rotation can be avoided by having air enter the box plenum from the side and by using a special splitter entrance fitting.

Gilman et al. (1951) proposed box plenum dimensions and entrance fitting designs to minimize unstable conditions as summarized in Figures 5 and 6. For residential systems with less than 1060 L/s capacity, pressure loss through the box plenum is approximately 12 Pa. This loss should be deducted from the available static pressure to determine the static pressure available for duct branches. In terms of equivalent length, add approximately 15 m to the measured branch runs.

Embedded Loop Ducts

In cold climates, floor slab construction requires that the floor and slab perimeter be heated to provide comfort and prevent condensation. The temperature drop (or rise) in the supply air is significant, and special design tables must be used to account for the different supply air temperatures at distant registers. Because duct heat losses may cause a large temperature drop, feed ducts need to be placed at critical points in the loop.

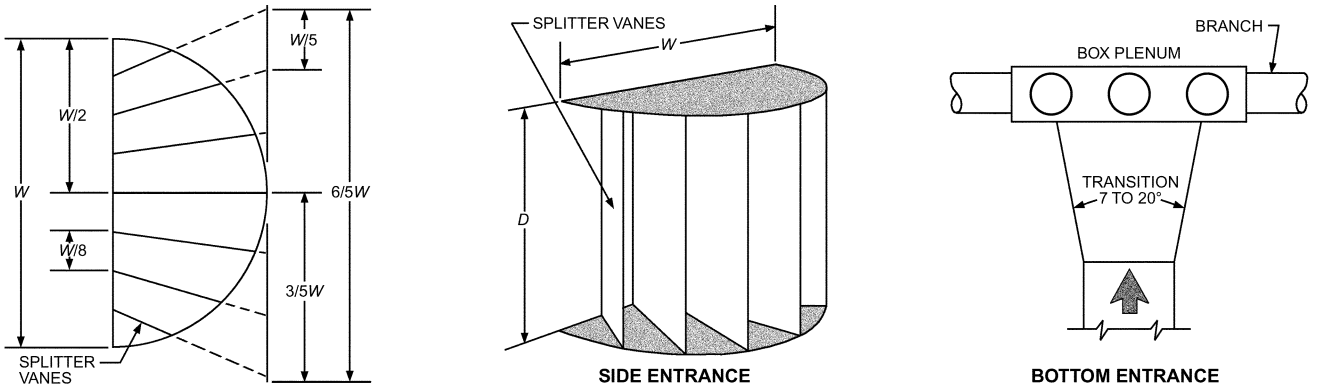

Fig. 5 Entrance Fittings to Eliminate Unstable Airflow in Box Plenum

A second aspect of a loop system is installation. The building site must be well drained and the surrounding grade sloped away from the structure. A vapor retarder must be installed under the slab. The bottom of the embedded duct must not be lower than the finished grade. Because a concrete slab loses heat from its edges outward through the foundation walls and downward through the earth, the edge must be properly insulated.

A typical loop duct is buried in the slab 50 to 450 mm from the outer edge and about 65 mm beneath the slab surface. If galvanized sheet metal is used for the duct, it must be coated on the outside to comply with Federal Specification SS-A-701. Other special materials used for ducts must be installed according to the manufacturer's instructions. In addition, care must be taken when the slab is poured not to puncture the vapor retarder or to crush or dislodge the ducts.

5. SMALL COMMERCIAL SYSTEMS

The duct design procedure described in this chapter can be applied to small commercial systems using residential equipment, if the application does not include moisture sources that create a large latent load.

In commercial applications that do not require low noise, air duct velocities may be increased to reduce duct size. Long throws from supply outlets are also required for large areas, and higher velocities may be required for that reason.

Commercial systems with significant variation in airflow for cooling, heating, and large internal loads (e.g., kitchens, theaters) should be designed in accordance with Chapters 20 and 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, Chapters 5 and 34 in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications,* and Chapters 19 to 21 of this volume.

Air Distribution in Small Commercial Buildings

According to Andrews et al. (2002), forced-air thermal distribution systems in small commercial buildings tend to be similar in many ways to those in residential buildings. As in most residential systems, there is often a single air handler that transfers heat or cooling from the equipment to an airstream that is then circulated through the building by means of ducts. Two major differences, however, may affect the performance of small commercial buildings: (1) significant (and often multiple) connections with outdoor air, and (2) the ceiling-space configuration.

Outdoor Air Connections. In small commercial buildings, many forced-air systems have an outdoor-air duct leading from the outdoors to the return side of the ductwork, used to provide ventilation. Ventilation may also be provided by a separate exhaust-air system consisting of a duct and fan blowing air out of the building. Finally, there may also be a makeup air system blowing air into the building, used to balance out all the other airflows. A malfunction in any of these components can compromise the energy efficiency and thermal comfort performance of the entire system.

Ceiling Space Configuration. Knowing the layout of the ceiling space is key to understanding uncontrolled airflows. The overhead portions of the air and thermal barriers can either be together, at the ceiling or at the roof, or separate, with the thermal barrier at the ceiling and the air barrier at the roof.

One configuration, typical of residential buildings but uncommon in commercial buildings, has a tight gypsum-board ceiling with insulation directly above and a vented attic. Ductwork is often placed in the vented attic space, though it may be elsewhere (e.g., under the building, outdoors). Such ducts are outside both the air and thermal barriers.

A more common configuration is similar except that it has a suspended T-bar ceiling instead of gypsum board. Air leakage through this type of ceiling tends to be quite high because the (usually leaky) suspended ceiling and attic vent provide an easy airflow path between the building and the outdoors. Efficiency is also compromised by duct placement in a very hot and humid location. Because of these two factors, uncontrolled airflows can strongly affect energy use, ventilation rates, and indoor humidity. This configuration should be avoided.

A third configuration is also similar, except that the ceiling space is not vented. This puts the ducts inside the air barrier (desirable) but outside the thermal barrier (undesirable). During the cooling season, the ceiling space tends to be very hot and dry. Uncontrolled airflows increase energy use but not ventilation rates or humidity levels.

The best configuration has insulation at the roof plane, leaving the space below the roof unvented, with or without a dropped ceiling. This design is very forgiving of uncontrolled airflow as long as the ductwork is inside the building. Duct leakage and unbalanced return air have little effect on energy use, ventilation rates, and indoor humidity, because conditions in the space below the roof deck are not greatly different from those in the rooms.

Controlling Airflow in New Buildings

Airflow control should be a key objective in designing small commercial buildings. Designers and builders can plan for proper airflows at the outset. The following design goals are recommended:

- *Design the building envelope to minimize effects of uncontrolled airflows.* Place the air and thermal barriers together in the roof, with ducts inside the conditioned zone. There are several good options for placing insulation at the roof level, including sprayed polymer foam, rigid insulation board on the roof deck beneath a rubber membrane, and insulating batts attached to the underside of the roof.
- *Minimize duct leakage to outdoors*. Make sure as much ductwork is in the conditioned envelope as possible. Do not vent the ceiling

space. If possible, dispense with the dropped ceiling altogether and use exposed ductwork. Avoid using building cavities as part of the air distribution system.

- *Minimize unbalanced return air.* The best way is to provide a ducted return for each zone, and then balance these with the supply ducts serving the respective zones. Where that is not possible, transfer ducts or grilles may be provided to link a zone without a return duct to another zone with a return duct, provided that these have a minimum of 950 mm^2 of net free area per L/s of return airflow. This approach should be used only if the thermal and air barriers are in the same plane (roof or ceiling).
- *Minimize unbalanced airflows across building envelope.* Design the exhaust system with the smallest airflow rates necessary to capture and remove targeted air contamination sources and meet applicable standards. Ensure that the sum of makeup and outdoor airflow rates exceeds the exhaust airflow rate, not only for the building as a whole but also for any zones that can be isolated. Unconditioned makeup air should equal 75 to 85% of exhaust airflow, where possible. In buildings where continuous ventilation is required and the climate is especially humid, special design options may be needed (e.g., a dedicated makeup air unit could be provided with its own desiccant dehumidifier).
- *Ensure proper operation of outdoor air dampers.* Outdoor air dampers on air handlers or rooftop air-conditioning units are frequently stuck or rusted shut, even on recently installed equipment. Proper performance helps ensure proper air quality and thermal comfort. Inspect space conditioning equipment annually to ensure proper operation of these dampers.

Further information can be found in Andrews et al. (2002).

6. TESTING FOR DUCT EFFICIENCY

ASHRAE *Standard* 152 describes ways of measuring duct leakage and of calculating the impact of all sorts of energy transfer mechanisms. It applies to single-family detached and attached residences with independent thermal distribution systems.

A major complication in the standard's lengthy development effort was the fact that, in contrast to heating or cooling units, which are mass-produced, duct systems are one of a kind. When determining the efficiency of a home duct system, it is therefore not possible to use the result of a laboratory test on a sample of the same model. Tests on a duct system must be performed in situ. The challenge was to produce a procedure that would be credibly accurate yet not too time consuming to apply. A detailed history of the standard's development is given in Andrews (2003).

ASHRAE Technical Committee 6.3, which is responsible for the standard, investigates possible revisions and extensions on an ongoing basis.

ASHRAE and other research organizations have conducted significant research and published numerous articles about methods for testing, and measured performance of the design and seasonal efficiencies of residential duct systems in the heating and cooling modes. A compilation of this research is provided in the Bibliography.

Although duct leakage is a major cause of duct inefficiency, other factors, such as heat conduction through duct walls, influence of fans on pressure in the house, and partial regain of lost heat, must also be taken into account. Following is a summary of information needed to evaluate the efficiency of a duct system using *Standard* 152 and a description of the results that the test method provides.

Data Inputs

Variables that are known or can be measured to provide the basis for calculating duct system efficiency include the following:

Local Climate Data. Three outdoor design temperatures are needed to describe an area's climate: one dry-bulb and one wet-bulb temperature for cooling, and one dry-bulb for heating.

Dimensions of Living Space. The volume of the conditioned space must be known to estimate the impact of the duct system on air infiltration. Typical, average values have been developed and if default options are used, the floor area of the conditioned space must be known.

Surface Areas of Ducts and R-Values of Insulation. The total surface area of supply and return ducts and the insulation R-value of each are needed for calculating conductive heat losses through the duct walls. Also needed is the fraction of supply and return ducts in each type of buffer zone (e.g., an attic, basement, or crawlspace).

Fan Flow Rate. *Standard* 152 allows a choice between two ways of measuring this quantity. An adjustable, calibrated fan flowmeter is the most accurate device for measuring airflow. The alternative method in the standard is to use a calibrated flow grid.

Duct Leakage to Outdoors. Air leakage from supply ducts to the outdoors and from the outdoors and buffer spaces into return ducts is another major factor that affects efficiency. Typically, 17% or more of the total airflow is leakage.

Data Output

Distribution efficiency is the main output of *Standard* 152. This figure of merit is the ratio of the input energy that would be needed to heat or cool the house if the duct system had no losses to the actual energy input required. Distribution efficiency also accounts for the effect the duct system has on equipment efficiency and the space conditioning load. Thus, distribution efficiency differs from delivery effectiveness, which is the simple output-to-input ratio for a duct system.

Four types of distribution efficiencies are considered. They relate to efficiency during either heating or cooling and for either design conditions or seasonal averages.

- Design distribution efficiency, heating
- Seasonal distribution efficiency, heating
- Design distribution efficiency, cooling
- Seasonal distribution efficiency, cooling

Design values of distribution efficiency are peak-load values that should be used when sizing equipment. Seasonal values should be used for determining annual energy use and subsequent costs.

STANDARDS

AHRI	
Standard 260	Sound Rating of Ducted Air Moving and Conditioning Equipment
Standard 610	Performance Rating of Central System Humidifiers for Residential Applications
ASHRAE	
Standard 90.2	Energy-Efficient Design of Low-Rise Residential Buildings
Standard 103	Methods of Testing for Annual Fuel Utilization Efficiency of Residential Central Furnaces and Boilers
Standard 152	Method of Test for Determining the Design and Seasonal Efficiencies of Residential Thermal Distribution Systems
ASTM	
Standard E1554	Standard Test Methods for Determining External Air Leakage of Air Distribution Systems by Fan Pressurization
NFPA	
Standard 90A	Standard for the Installation of Air-Conditioning and Ventilating Systems
Standard 90B	Standard for the Installation of Warm Air Heating and Air-Conditioning Systems
Standard 501	Standard for Manufactured Housing
ACCA	
Manual D	Residential Duct Systems
Manual J	Residential Load Calculations
Manual S	Residential Equipment Selection
Manual Zr	Residential Zoning

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CHAPTER 11

STEAM SYSTEMS

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STEAM systems use the vapor phase of water to supply heat or kinetic energy through a piping system. As a source of heat, steam can heat a conditioned space with suitable terminal heat transfer equipment such as fan-coil units, unit heaters, radiators, and convectors (finned tube or cast iron), or through a heat exchanger that supplies hot water or some other heat transfer medium to the terminal units. In addition, steam is commonly used in heat exchangers (shell-and-tube, plate, or coil types) to heat domestic hot water and supply heat for industrial and commercial processes such as in laundries and kitchens. Steam is also used as a heat source for certain cooling processes such as single-stage and two-stage absorption refrigeration machines.

1. ADVANTAGES

Steam offers the following advantages:

- Steam flows through the system unaided by external energy sources such as pumps.
- Because of its low density, steam can be used in tall buildings where water systems create excessive pressure.
- Terminal units can be added or removed without making basic changes to the design.
- Steam components can be repaired or replaced by closing the steam supply, without the difficulties associated with draining and refilling a water system.
- Steam is pressure/temperature dependent; therefore, the system temperature can be controlled by varying either steam pressure or temperature.
- Steam can be distributed throughout a heating system with little change in temperature.

In view of these advantages, steam is applicable to the following facilities:

- Where heat is required for process and comfort heating, such as in industrial plants, hospitals, laboratories, restaurants, dry-cleaning plants, laundries, and commercial buildings
- Where clean steam is required for humidification and/or sterilization (it can be provided using an unfired steam generator)
- Where the heating medium must travel great distances, such as in facilities with scattered building locations, or where the building height would result in excessive pressure in a water system
- Where intermittent changes in heat load occur

2. FUNDAMENTALS

Steam is the vapor phase of water and is generated by adding more heat than required to maintain its liquid phase at a given pressure, causing the liquid to change to vapor without any further increase in temperature. Table 1 shows the pressure/temperature relationship and various other properties of steam.

Temperature is the thermal state of both liquid and vapor at any given pressure. The values shown in Table 1 are for dry saturated steam. The vapor temperature can be raised by adding more heat, resulting in superheated steam, which is used (1) where higher temperatures are required, (2) in large distribution systems to compensate for heat losses and to ensure that steam is delivered at the desired saturated pressure and temperature, and (3) to ensure that the

Table 1 Properties of Saturated Steam

Absolute Pressure, kPa	Saturation Temperature, °C	Specific Volume, m^3/kg		Enthalpy, kJ/kg		
		Liquid v_f	Steam v_g	Liquid h_f	Evaporation h_{fg}	Steam h_g
19.9	60	0.00102	7.669	251	2358	2609
47.4	80	0.00103	3.405	335	2308	2643
101	100	0.00104	1.672	419	2256	2675
199	120	0.00106	0.891	504	2202	2706
362	140	0.00108	0.508	589	2144	2733
618	160	0.00110	0.307	676	2082	2758
1003	180	0.00113	0.194	763	2015	2778
1555	200	0.00116	0.127	852	1941	2793

Note: Values are rounded off or approximated to show various properties discussed in the text. For calculation and design, use values of thermodynamic properties of water shown in Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* or a similar table.

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steam is dry and contains no entrained liquid that could damage some turbine-driven equipment.

Enthalpy of the liquid h_f (sensible heat) is the amount of heat in kilojoules required to raise the temperature of a kilogram of water from 0°C to the boiling point at the pressure indicated.

Enthalpy of evaporation h_{fg} (latent heat of vaporization) is the amount of heat required to change a kilogram of boiling water at a given pressure to a kilogram of steam at the same pressure. This same amount of heat is released when the vapor is condensed back to a liquid.

Enthalpy of the steam h_g (total heat) is the combined enthalpy of liquid and vapor and represents the total heat above 0°C in the steam.

Specific volume, the reciprocal of density, is the volume of unit mass and indicates the volumetric space that 1 kg of steam or water occupies.

An understanding of the above helps explain some of the following unique properties and advantages of steam:

- Most of the heat content of steam is stored as latent heat, which permits large quantities of heat to be transmitted efficiently with little change in temperature. Because the temperature of saturated steam is pressure dependent, a negligible temperature reduction occurs from the reduction in pressure caused by pipe friction losses as steam flows through the system.
- Steam, like all fluids, flows from areas of high pressure to areas of low pressure and can move throughout a system without an external energy source. Heat dissipation causes the vapor to condense, which creates a reduction in pressure caused by the dramatic change in specific volume (1600:1 at atmospheric pressure).
- As steam gives up its latent heat at the terminal equipment, the condensate that forms is initially at the same pressure and temperature as the steam. When this condensate is discharged to a lower pressure (as when a steam trap passes condensate to the return system), the condensate contains more heat than necessary to maintain the liquid phase at the lower pressure; this excess heat causes some of the liquid to vaporize or "flash" to steam at the lower pressure. The amount of liquid that flashes to steam can be calculated as follows:

$$\% \text{ Flash steam} = \frac{100(h_{f1} - h_{f2})}{h_{fg2}} \quad (1)$$

where

h_{f1} = enthalpy of liquid at pressure p_1
h_{f2} = enthalpy of liquid at pressure p_2
h_{fg2} = latent heat of vaporization at pressure p_2

Flash steam contains significant and useful heat energy that can be recovered and used (see the section on Heat Recovery). This reevaporation of condensate can be controlled (minimized) by subcooling the condensate in the terminal equipment before it discharges into the return piping. The volume of condensate that is subcooling should not be so large as to cause a significant loss of heat transfer (condensing) surface.

3. EFFECTS OF WATER, AIR, AND GASES

Enthalpies in Table 1 are for dry saturated steam. Most systems operate near these theoretically available values, but the presence of water and gases can affect enthalpy and have other adverse operating effects.

Dry saturated steam is pure vapor without entrained water droplets. However, some amount of water usually carries over as condensate forms because of heat losses in the distribution system. **Steam quality** describes the amount of water present and can be determined by calorimeter tests. The quality of saturated steam can be improved by installing a separator in-line before the equipment. The steam separator removes condensate that forms in a steam system and thus improves steam quality.

Although steam quality might not have a significant effect on the heat transfer capabilities of the terminal equipment, the backing up or presence of condensate can be significant because the enthalpy of condensate h_f is negligible compared with the enthalpy of evaporation h_{fg}. If condensate does not drain properly from pipes and coils, the rapidly flowing steam can push a slug of condensate through the system. This can cause water hammer and result in objectionable noise and damage to piping and system components.

The presence of air also reduces steam temperature. Air reduces heat transfer because it migrates to and insulates heat transfer surfaces. Further, oxygen in the system causes pitting of iron and steel surfaces. Carbon dioxide (CO_2) traveling with steam dissolves in condensate, forming **carbonic acid**, which is extremely corrosive to steam heating pipes and heat transfer equipment.

The combined adverse effects of water, air, and CO_2 necessitate their prompt and efficient removal.

4. HEAT TRANSFER

The quantity of steam that must be supplied to a heat exchanger to transfer a specific amount of heat is a function of (1) the steam temperature and quality, (2) the character and entering and leaving temperatures of the medium to be heated, and (3) the heat exchanger design. For a more detailed discussion of heat transfer, see Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

5. BASIC STEAM SYSTEM DESIGN

Because of the various codes and regulations governing the design and operation of boilers, pressure vessels, and systems, steam systems are classified according to operating pressure. **Low-pressure systems** operate up to 100 kPa (gage), and **high-pressure system**s operate over 100 kPa (gage). There are many subclassifications within these broad classifications, especially for heating systems such as one- and two-pipe, gravity, vacuum, or variable vacuum return systems. However, these subclassifications relate to the distribution system or temperature-control method. Regardless of classification, all steam systems include a source of steam, a distribution system, and terminal equipment, where steam is used as the source of power or heat.

6. STEAM SOURCE

Steam can be generated directly by boilers using oil, gas, coal, wood, or waste as a fuel source, or by solar, nuclear, or electrical energy as a heat source. Steam can be generated indirectly by recovering heat from processes or equipment such as gas turbines and diesel or gas engines. Cogeneration of electricity and steam should always be considered for facilities that have year-round steam requirements. Where steam is used as a power source (e.g., in turbine-driven equipment), exhaust steam may be used in heat transfer equipment for process and space heating.

Steam can be provided by a facility's own boiler or cogeneration plant or can be purchased from a central utility serving a city, campus, or specific geographic area. This distinction can be very important. A facility with its own boiler plant usually has a closed-loop system and requires the condensate to be as hot as possible when it returns to the boiler. There are two types of condensate pumps: electrical and mechanical (or pressure powered). Electric condensate return pumps require a few degrees of subcooling to prevent cavitation or flashing of condensate to vapor at the suction eye of pump impellers. The degree of subcooling varies, depending on the hydraulic design or characteristics of the pump in use. (See the section on Net Positive Suction Characteristics in Chapter 44.) Mechan-

ical condensate return pumps do not have impellers; they use steam or air as the driving force to pump condensate back to the boiler and therefore do not require subcooling.

Central utilities may or may not take back condensate. When condensate is not accepted by the central utility, it is discharged by the using facility and results in an open-loop system. If a utility does take back condensate, it rarely gives credit for its heat content. If condensate is returned at 80°C, and a heat recovery system reduces this temperature to 25°C, the heat remaining in the condensate represents 10 to 15% of the heat purchased from the utility. Using this heat effectively can reduce steam and heating costs by 10% or more (see the section on Heat Recovery).

Boilers

Fired and waste heat boilers are usually constructed and labeled according to the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* because pressures normally exceed 100 kPa (gage). Details on design, construction, and application of boilers can be found in Chapter 32. Boiler selection is based on the combined loads, including heating processes and equipment that use steam, hot-water generation, piping losses, and pickup allowance. In existing systems, if steam equipment and distribution will be reused, replacement boilers are sized based on the existing connected loads.

The Hydronics Institute Division of AHRI testing standard (AHRI *Standard* 1500) is used to test and rate most low-pressure heating boilers that have net and gross ratings. In smaller systems, selection is based on a net rating. Larger system selection is made on a gross load basis. The occurrence and nature of the load components, with respect to the total load, determine the number of boilers used in an installation.

Heat Recovery and Waste Heat Boilers

Steam can be generated by waste heat, such as exhaust from fuel-fired engines and turbines. Figure 1 shows a typical exhaust boiler and heat recovery system used for diesel engines. A portion of the water used to cool the engine block is diverted as preheated makeup water to the exhaust heat boiler to obtain maximum heat and energy efficiency. Where the quantity of steam generated by the waste heat boiler is not steady or ample enough to satisfy the facility's steam requirements, a conventional boiler must generate supplemental steam.

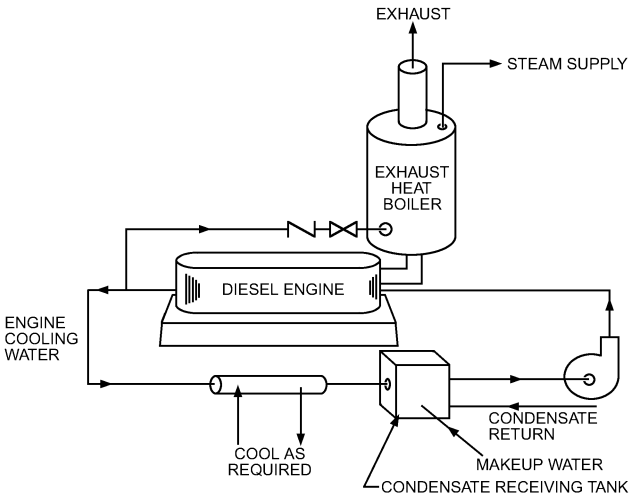

Fig. 1 Exhaust Heat Boiler

Heat Exchangers

Heat exchangers are used in most steam systems. Steam-to-water heat exchangers (sometimes called converters or storage tanks with steam heating elements) are generally used to heat domestic hot water and to supply heating water to terminal equipment. These heat exchangers are plate or shell-and-tube, where the steam is admitted to the shell and the water is heated as it circulates through the tubes. Condensate coolers (water-to-water) are sometimes used to subcool the condensate while reclaiming the heat energy.

Water-to-steam heat exchangers (steam generators) are used in high-temperature water (HTW) systems to provide process steam. Such heat exchangers generally consist of a U-tube bundle, through which the HTW circulates, installed in a tank or pressure vessel.

All heat exchangers should be constructed and labeled according to the applicable ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*. Many jurisdictions require double-wall construction in shell-and-tube heat exchangers between the steam and potable water. Additional detail on the design, construction, and application of heat exchangers is in Chapter 47.

7. BOILER CONNECTIONS

Figure 2 shows recommended boiler connections for pumped and gravity return systems; check local codes for specific requirements.

Supply Piping

Small boilers usually have one steam outlet connection sized to reduce steam velocity to minimize carryover of water into supply lines. Large boilers can have several outlets that minimize boiler water entrainment. The boiler manufacturer's recommendations concerning near-boiler piping should be followed because this piping may act as a steam/liquid separator for the boiler.

Figure 2 shows piping connections to the steam header. Although some engineers prefer to use an enlarged steam header for additional storage space, if there is no sudden demand for steam except during the warm-up period, an oversized header may be a disadvantage. The boiler header can be the same size as the boiler connection or the pipe used on the steam main. Horizontal runouts from the boiler(s) to the header should be sized by calculating the heaviest load that will be placed on the boiler(s). Runouts should be sized on the same basis as the building mains. Any change in size after the vertical uptakes should be made by reducing elbows.

Return Piping

Cast-iron boilers have return tappings on both sides, and steel boilers may have one or two return tappings. Where two tappings are provided, both should be used to effect proper circulation through the boiler. Condensate in boilers can be returned by a pump or a gravity return system. Return connections shown in Figure 2 for a multiple-boiler gravity return installation may not always maintain the correct water level in all boilers. Extra controls or accessories may be required.

Recommended return piping connections for systems using gravity return are detailed in Figure 3. Dimension A must be at least 100 mm for each 1 kPa (gage) maintained at the boiler to provide the pressure required to return the condensate to the boiler. To provide a reasonable safety factor, make dimension A at least 355 mm for small systems with piping sized for a pressure drop of 0.9 kPa, and at least 710 mm for larger systems with piping sized for a pressure drop of 3.5 kPa. The **Hartford loop** protects against a low water condition, which can occur if a leak develops in the wet return portion of the piping. The Hartford loop takes the place of a check valve on the wet return; however, certain local codes require check valves. Because of hydraulic pressure limitations, gravity return systems are only suitable for systems operating at a boiler pressure between 3.5 and 7 kPa (gage). However, because

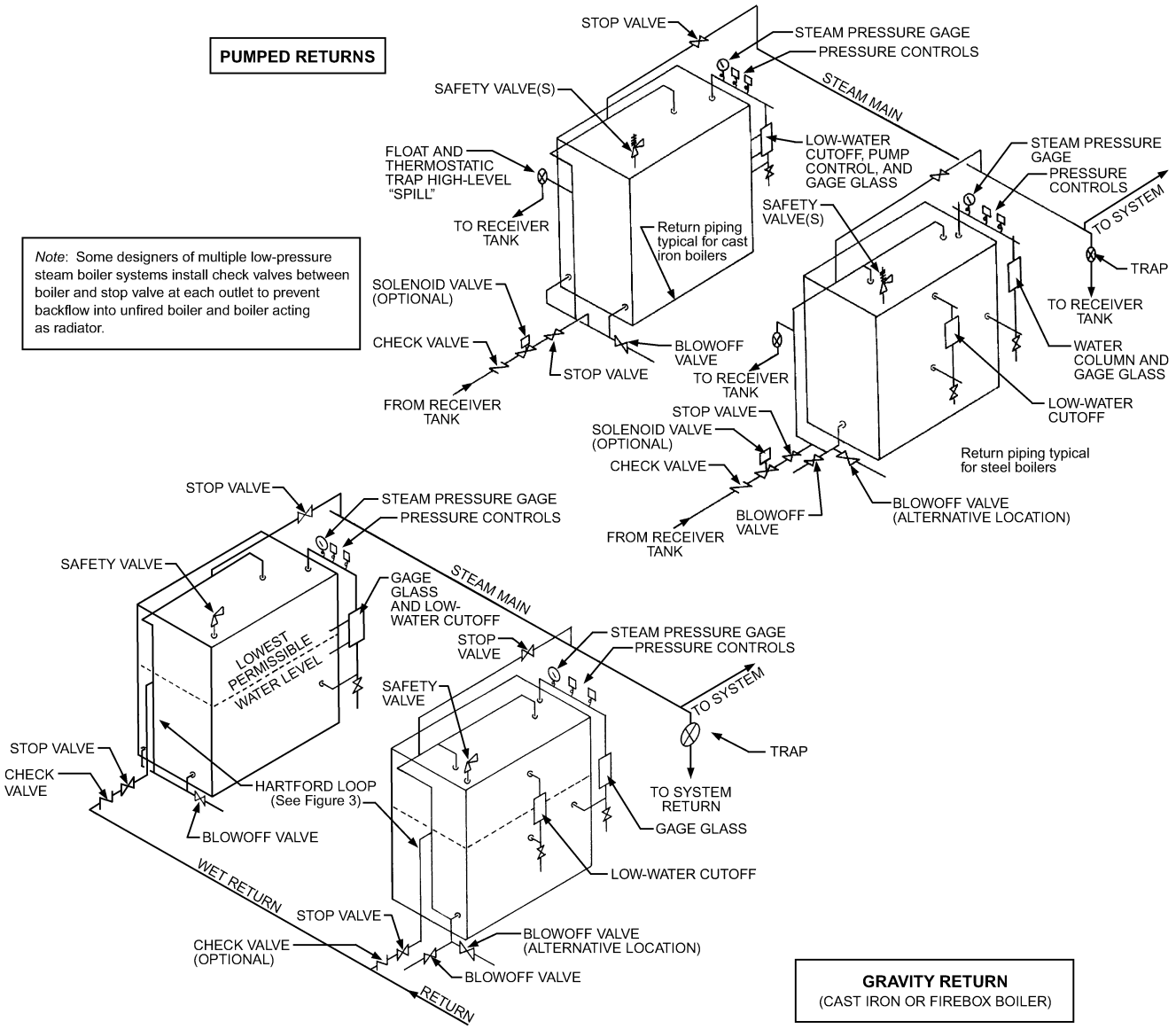

Fig. 2 Typical Boiler Connections

these systems have minimum mechanical equipment and low initial installed cost, they are appropriate for many small systems. Kremers (1982) and Stamper and Koral (1979) provide additional design information on piping for gravity return systems.

Recommended piping connections for steam boilers with pump-returned condensate are shown in Figure 2. Common practice provides an individual condensate or boiler feedwater pump for each boiler. Pump operation is controlled by the boiler water level control on each boiler. However, one pump may be connected to supply the water to each boiler from a single manifold by using feedwater control valves regulated by the individual boiler water level controllers. When such systems are used, the condensate return pump runs continuously to pressurize the return header.

Return piping should be sized based on total load. The line between the pump and boiler should be sized to match pressure losses from pipes and fittings, boiler head pressure, and the maximum pump discharge flow rate.

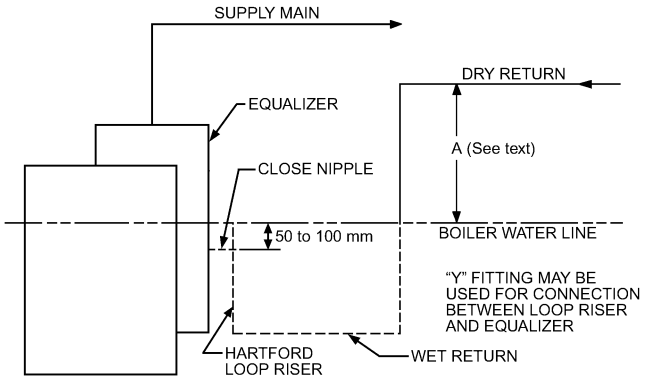

Fig. 3 Boiler with Gravity Return

8. DESIGN STEAM PRESSURE

One of the most important decisions in the design of a steam system is selecting the generating, distribution, and usage pressures. Considering investment cost, energy efficiency, and control stability, the pressure should be held to the minimum values above atmospheric pressure that accomplish the required heating task, unless detailed economic analysis indicates advantages in higher pressure generation and distribution.

The first step in selecting pressures is to analyze the load requirements. Space heating and domestic water heating can best be served, directly or indirectly, with low-pressure steam less than 100 kPa (gage) or 120°C. Other systems that can be served with low-pressure steam include single-stage absorption units [70 kPa (gage)], cooking, warming, dishwashing, and snow-melting heat exchangers. Thus, from the standpoint of load requirements, high-pressure steam [above 100 kPa (gage)] is required only for loads such as dryers, autoclaves, presses, molding dies, power drives, and other processing, sterilizing, manufacturing, and power requirements. The load requirement establishes the pressure requirement.

When the source is close to the load(s), the generation pressure should be high enough to provide the (1) load design pressure, (2) friction losses between the generator and the load, and (3) control range. Losses are caused by flow through the piping, fittings, control valves, and strainers. If the generator(s) is located remote from the loads, there could be some economic advantage in distributing the steam at a higher pressure to reduce pipe size. When this is considered, the economic analysis should include the additional investment and operating costs associated with a higher pressure generation system. When an increase in the generating pressure requires a change from below to above 100 kPa (gage), the generating system equipment changes from low-pressure class to high-pressure class and there are significant increases in both investment and operating cost.

Where steam is provided from a nonfired device or prime mover such as a diesel engine cooling jacket, the source device can have an inherent pressure limitation.

9. PIPING

The piping system distributes the steam, returns the condensate, and removes air and noncondensable gases. In steam heating systems, it is important that the piping distribute steam, not only at full design load, but also at partial and excess loads that can occur on system warm-up. The usual average winter steam demand is less than half the demand at the lowest outdoor design temperature. However, when the system is warming up, the load on the steam mains and returns can exceed the maximum operating load for the coldest design day, even in moderate weather. This load comes from raising the temperature of the piping to the steam temperature and that of the building to the indoor design temperature. Supply and return piping should be sized according to Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Supply Piping Design Considerations

1. Size pipe according to Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, taking into consideration pressure drop and steam velocity.
2. Pitch piping uniformly down in the direction of steam flow at 2 mm per metre. If piping cannot be pitched down in the direction of the steam flow, see Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for rules on pipe sizing and pitch.
3. Insulate piping well to avoid unnecessary heat loss (see Chapter 23 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*).
4. Condensate from unavoidable heat loss in the distribution system must be removed promptly to eliminate water hammer and degradation of steam quality and heat transfer capability. Install drip legs at all low points and natural drainage points in the system, such as at the ends of mains and the bottoms of risers, and ahead of pressure regulators, control valves, isolation valves, pipe bends, and expansion joints. On straight horizontal runs with no natural drainage points, space drip legs at intervals not exceeding 90 m when the pipe is pitched down in the direction of the steam flow and at a maximum of 45 m when the pipe is pitched up, so that condensate flow is opposite of steam flow. These distances apply to systems where valves are opened manually to remove air and excess condensate that forms during warm-up conditions. Reduce these distances by about half in systems that are warmed up automatically.
5. Where horizontal piping must be reduced in size, use eccentric reducers that allow continuing a uniform pitch along the bottom of piping (in downward-pitched systems). Avoid concentric reducers on horizontal piping, because they can cause water hammer.
6. Take off all branch lines from the top of the steam mains.
7. Where the length of a branch takeoff is less than 3 m, the branch line can be pitched back toward the main at 4 mm per metre, providing drip legs as described in item 4.
8. Size drip legs properly to separate and collect the condensate. Drip legs at vertical risers should be full-size and extend beyond the riser, as shown in Figure 4. Drip legs at other locations should be the same diameter as the main. In steam mains 150 mm and over, this can be reduced to half the diameter of the main, but to no less than 100 mm. Where warm-up is supervised, the length of the collecting leg is not critical. However, the recommended length is 1.5 times the pipe diameter and not less than 200 mm. For automatic warm-up, collecting legs should always be the same size as the main and should be at least 710 mm long to provide the hydraulic pressure differential necessary for the trap to discharge before a positive pressure is built up in the steam main.
9. Condensate should flow by gravity from the trap to the return piping system. Where the steam trap is located below the return line, the condensate must be lifted. In some situations when pressure is always adequate, the trap discharge can be piped directly to the return system (Figure 5). However, back pressure

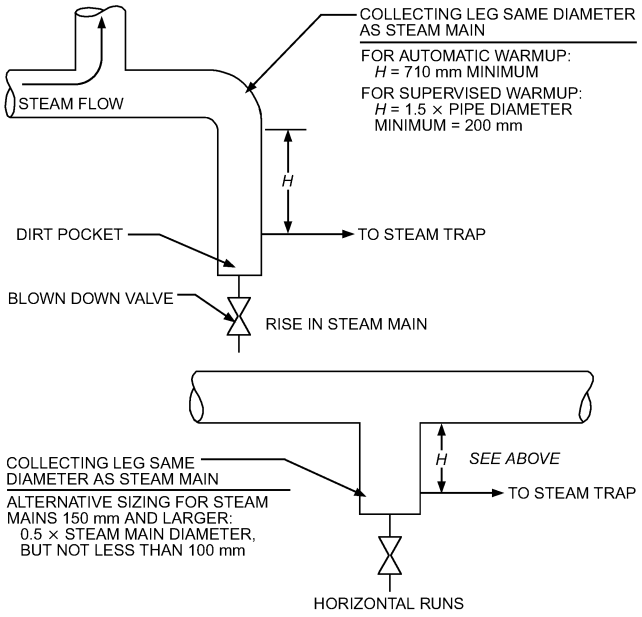

Fig. 4 Method of Dripping Steam Mains

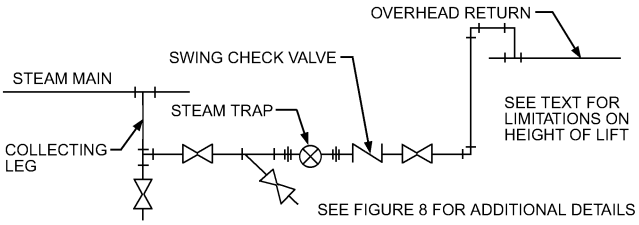

Fig. 5 Trap Discharging to Overhead Return

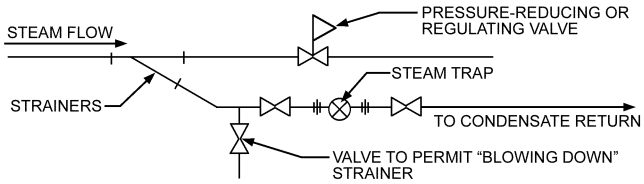

Fig. 6 Trapping Strainers

at the trap discharge (return line pressure plus hydraulic pressure created by height of lift) must not exceed steam main pressure, and the trap must be sized after considering back pressure. A collecting leg must be used and the trap discharge must flow by gravity to a vented condensate receiver, from which it is pumped to the overhead return in systems (1) where the temperature is regulated by modulating the steam control valves, or (2) where the back pressure at the trap is close to system pressure. An example of a system requiring a pump follows. The steam system pressure is 207 kPa (gage). The pressure in the condensate return line is 172 kPa (gage) and the condensate return line is elevated 6.7 m above the trap discharge pipe. To determine the pressure to lift the condensate, the height (in metres) is multiplied by 10.3. Adding the condensate return line pressure [172 kPa (gage)] and the back pressure created from the height of lift [68 kPa (gage)], the total back pressure is 240 kPa (gage), which is greater than the steam system pressure and therefore requires a pump to lift the condensate to the overhead return.

10. Strainers installed before the pressure-reducing and control valves are a natural water collection point. Because water carryover can erode the valve seat, install a trap at the strainer blowdown connection (Figure 6). Another option is to place the strainer on its side to prevent condensate from collecting in the strainer's blowdown.

Terminal Equipment Piping Design Considerations

1. Size piping the same as the supply and return connections of the terminal equipment.
2. Keep equipment and piping accessible for inspection and maintenance of the steam traps and control valves.
3. Minimize strain caused by expansion and contraction with pipe bends, loops, or three elbow swings to take advantage of piping flexibility, or with expansion joints or flexible pipe connectors.
4. In multiple-coil applications, separately trap each coil for proper drainage (Figure 7). Piping two or more coils to a common header served by a single trap can cause condensate back-up, improper heat transfer, and inadequate temperature control.
5. Terminal equipment, where temperature is regulated by a modulating steam control valve, requires special consideration. See the section on Condensate Removal from Temperature-Regulated Equipment.

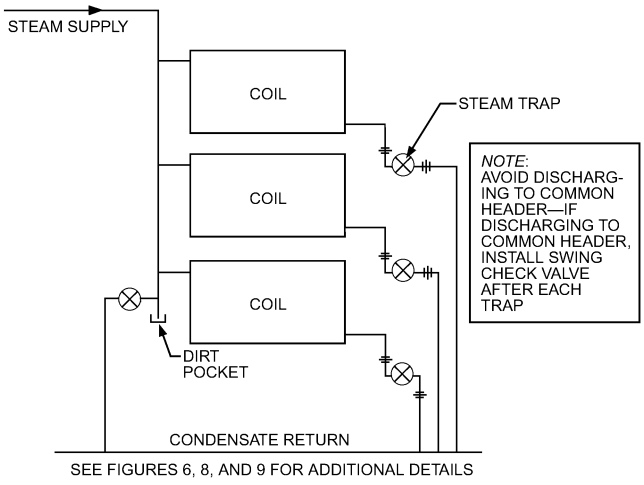

Fig. 7 Trapping Multiple Coils

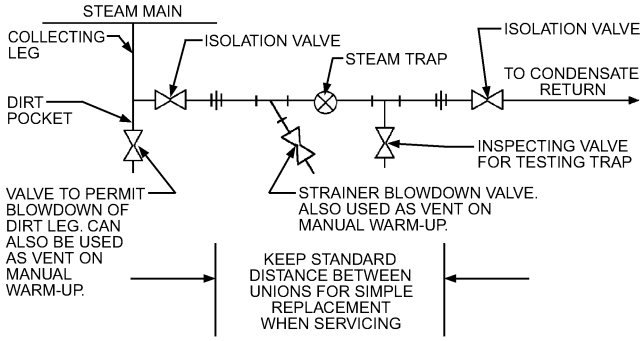

Fig. 8 Recommended Steam Trap Piping

Return Piping Design Considerations

1. Flow in the return line is two-phase, consisting of steam and condensate. See Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for sizing considerations.
2. Pitch return lines downward in the direction of the condensate flow at 4 mm per metre to ensure prompt condensate removal.
3. Insulate the return line well, especially where the condensate is returned to the boiler or the condensate enthalpy is recovered. In vacuum systems, the return lines are not insulated since condensate subcooling is required.
4. Where possible and practical, use heat recovery systems to recover the condensate enthalpy. See the section on Heat Recovery.
5. Equip dirt pockets of the drip legs and strainer blowdowns with valves to remove dirt and scale.
6. Install steam traps close to drip legs and make them accessible for inspection and repair. Servicing is simplified by making the pipe sizes and configuration identical for a given type and size of trap. The piping arrangement in Figure 8 facilitates inspection and maintenance of steam traps.
7. When elevating condensate to an overhead return, consider the pressure at the trap inlet and the fact that it requires approximately 10 kPa to elevate condensate 1 m. See item 9 in the section on Supply Piping Design Considerations for a complete discussion.

10. CONDENSATE REMOVAL FROM TEMPERATURE-REGULATED EQUIPMENT

When air, water, or another product is heated, the temperature or heat transfer rate can be regulated by a modulating steam pressure

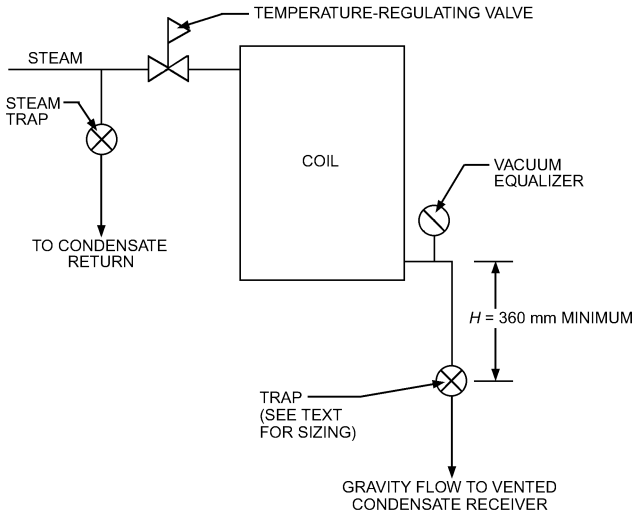

Fig. 9 Trapping Temperature-Regulated Coils

control valve. Because pressure and temperature do not vary at the same rate as load, the steam trap capacity, which is determined by the pressure differential between the trap inlet and outlet, may be adequate at full load, but not at some lesser load.

Analysis shows that steam pressure must be reduced dramatically to achieve a slight lowering of temperature. In most applications, this can result in subatmospheric pressure in the coil, while as much as 75% of the full condensate load has to be handled by the steam trap. This is especially important for coils exposed to outdoor air, because subatmospheric conditions can occur in the coil at outdoor temperatures below 0°C, and the coil will freeze if the condensate is not removed.

Armers (1985) provides detailed methods for determining condensate load under various operating conditions. However, in most cases, this load need not be calculated if the coils are piped as shown in Figure 9 and this procedure is followed:

1. Place the steam trap 300 to 900 mm below the bottom of the steam coil to provide a pressure of approximately 3.5 to 10.3 kPa (gage). Locating the trap at less than 300 mm usually results in improper drainage and operating difficulties.
2. Install vacuum breakers between the coil and trap inlet to ensure that the pressure can drain the coil when it is atmospheric or subatmospheric. The vacuum breaker should respond to a differential pressure of no greater than 750 Pa. For atmospheric returns, the vacuum breaker should be opened to the atmosphere, and the return system must be designed to ensure no pressurization of the return line. In vacuum return systems, the vacuum breaker should be piped to the return line.
3. Discharge from the trap must flow by gravity, without any lifts in the piping, to the return system, which must be vented properly to the atmosphere to eliminate any back pressure that could prevent the trap from draining the coil. Where the return main is overhead, the trap discharge should flow by gravity to a vented receiver, from which it is then pumped to the overhead return.
4. Design traps to operate at maximum pressure at the control valve inlet and size them to handle the full condensate load at a pressure differential equal to the hydraulic pressure between the trap and coil. The actual condensate load can vary from the theoretical design load because of the safety factors used in coil selection and the fact that condensate does not always form at a uniform steady rate; therefore, size steam traps according to the following:

   For an actual steam pressure p_1 in the coil at full condensate load w, the proportion X of full load needing atmospheric pressure at the coil is

$$X = \frac{100 - t_c}{t_s - t_c} \quad (2)$$

   where

   t_c = control temperature, °C
   t_s = steam temperature at p_1, °C

   Then, the steam trap must be sized both to pass the full load w at a differential pressure equal to p_1 and to pass $X \times w$ (the proportion of full load) at 3.5 kPa.
5. To reduce the possibility of a steam coil freezing, the temperature-regulating valve is often left wide open, and the leaving air temperature is controlled by a face-and-bypass damper on the steam coil.
6. For air temperatures below freezing, traps selected for draining steam coils should fail open (e.g., bucket traps) or two traps in parallel should be used.

11. STEAM TRAPS

Steam traps are an essential part of all steam systems, except one-pipe steam heating systems. Traps discharge condensate, which forms as steam gives up some of its heat, and direct the air and noncondensable gases to a point of removal. Condensate forms in steam mains and distribution piping because of unavoidable heat losses through less-than-perfect insulation, as well as in terminal equipment such as radiators, convectors, fan-coil units, and heat exchangers, where steam gives up heat during normal operation. Condensate must always be removed from the system as soon as it accumulates for the following reasons:

- Although condensate contains some valuable heat, using this heat by holding the condensate in the terminal equipment reduces the heat transfer surface. It also causes other operating problems because it retains air, which further reduces heat transfer, and noncondensable gases such as CO_2, which cause corrosion. As discussed in the section on Steam Source, recovering condensate heat is usually only desirable when the condensate is not returned to the boiler. Methods for this are discussed in the section on Heat Recovery.
- Steam moves rapidly in mains and supply piping, so when condensate accumulates to the point where the steam can push a slug of it, serious damage can occur from the resulting water hammer.

Ideally, the steam trap should remove all condensate promptly, along with air and noncondensable gases that might be in the system, with little or no loss of live steam. A steam trap is an automatic valve that can distinguish between steam and condensate or other fluids. Traps are classified as follows:

- **Thermostatic traps** react to the difference in the temperatures of steam and condensate.
- **Mechanical traps** depend on the difference in the densities of steam and condensate.
- **Kinetic traps** rely on the difference in the flow characteristics of steam and condensate.

The following points apply to all steam traps:

- No single type of steam trap is best suited to all applications, and most systems require more than one type of trap.
- Steam traps, regardless of type, should be carefully sized for the application and condensate load to be handled, because both undersizing and oversizing can cause serious problems. Undersizing can result in undesirable condensate back-up and excessive cycling, which can lead to premature failure. Oversizing might

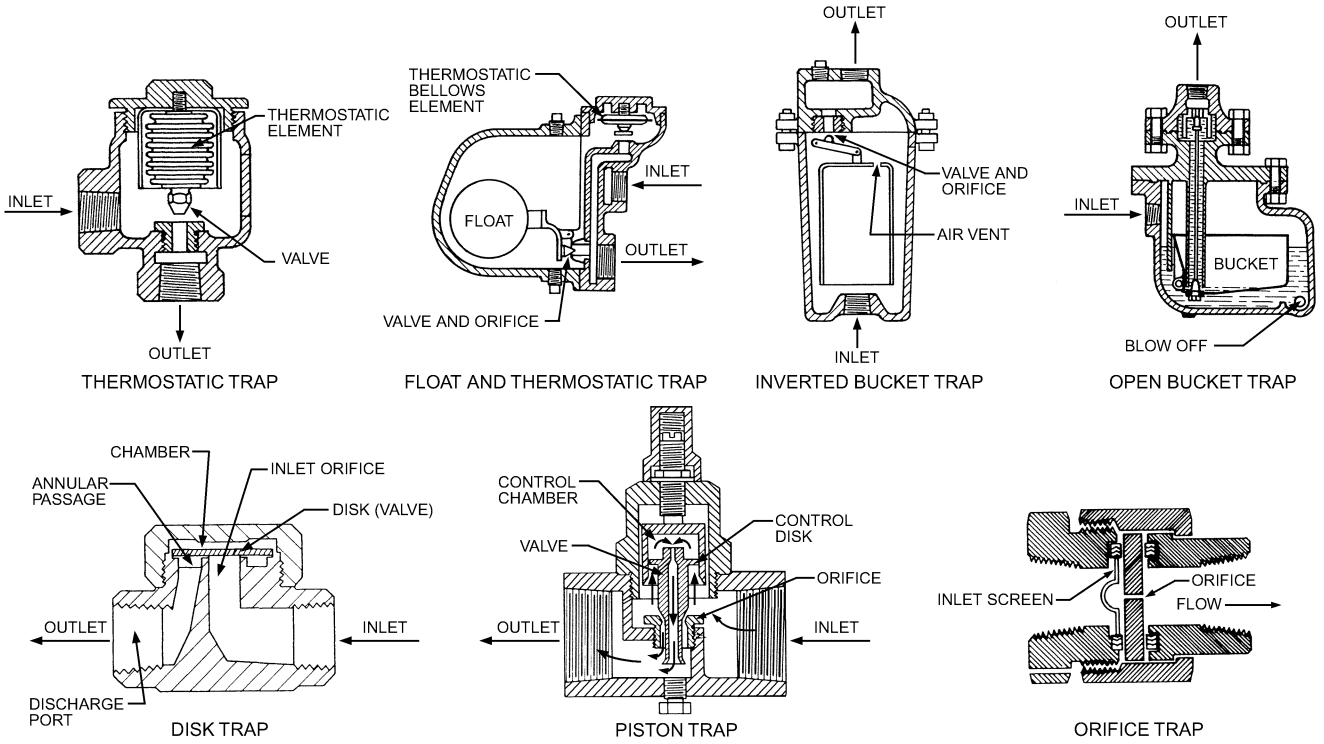

Fig. 10 Steam Traps

Table 2 Load/Sizing Safety Factors

Application	Steady-State Steam Pressure (No Modulating Control Valve)	Varying Steam Pressure (With Modulating Control Valve)
Steam mains (assumes supervised warm-up)	1.5 to 2	N/A
Heat exchanger	1.5 to 2	2 to 3
Storage heater	1.5 to 2	2 to 3
Air-heating coils	1.5 to 2	2 to 3
Submerged coils, low-level drain	1.5 to 2	N/A
siphon drain upward	2 to 3	N/A
Rotating cylinders	2 to 3	N/A
Tracing lines	1.5 to 2	N/A
Platen press	1.5 to 2	N/A

Source: FCI *Standard* 13-1.

appear to solve this problem and make selection much easier because fewer different sizes are required, but if the trap fails, excessive steam can be lost.

- Steam traps should be sized with a safety factor, which will vary by application. Table 2 gives recommended safety factors by application.

Steam traps should be installed with unions or flanges to facilitate maintenance and/or replacement.

Thermostatic Traps

In thermostatic traps, a bellows or bimetallic element operates a valve that opens in the presence of subcooled condensate and closes in the presence of steam (Figure 10). Because condensate is initially at the same temperature as the steam from which it was condensed, the thermostatic element must be designed and calibrated to open at a temperature below the steam temperature; otherwise, the trap would blow live steam continuously. Therefore, the condensate is subcooled by allowing it to back up in the trap and in a portion of the upstream drip leg piping, both of which are left uninsulated. Some thermostatic traps operate with a continuous water leg behind the trap so there is no steam loss; however, this prohibits discharge of air and noncondensable gases and can cause excessive condensate to back up into the mains or terminal equipment, thereby resulting in operating problems. Devices that operate without significant back-up can lose steam before the trap closes.

Although both bellows and bimetallic traps are temperature sensitive, their operations are significantly different. The **bellows thermostatic trap** has a fluid with a lower boiling point than water. When the trap is cold, the element is contracted and the discharge port is open. As hot condensate enters the trap, it causes the contents of the bellows to boil and vaporize before the condensate temperature rises to steam temperature. Because the contents of the bellows boil at a lower temperature than water, the vapor pressure inside the bellows element is greater than the steam pressure outside, causing the element to expand and close the discharge port.

Assuming the contained liquid has a pressure/temperature relationship similar to that of water, the balance of forces acting on the bellows element remains relatively constant, no matter how the

steam pressure varies. Therefore, this is a balanced pressure device that can be used at any pressure within the operating range of the device. However, this device should not be used where superheated steam is present, because the temperature is no longer in step with the pressure, and the bellows element can be damaged or ruptured.

Bellows thermostatic traps are best suited for steady light loads on low-pressure service. They are most widely used in radiators and convectors in HVAC applications.

The **bimetallic thermostatic trap** has an element made from metals with different expansion coefficients. Heat causes the element to change shape, permitting the valve port to open or close. Because a bimetallic element responds only to temperature, most traps have the valve on the outlet so that steam pressure is trying to open the valve. Therefore, by properly designing the bimetallic element, the trap can operate on a pressure/temperature curve approaching the steam saturation curve, although not as closely as a balanced pressure bellows element.

Unlike the bellows thermostatic trap, bimetallic thermostatic traps are not adversely affected by superheated steam or subject to damage by water hammer, so they can be readily used for high-pressure applications. They are best suited for steam tracers, jacketed piping, and heat transfer equipment, where some condensate back-up is tolerable. If they are used on steam main drip legs, the element should not back up condensate.

Mechanical Traps

Mechanical traps are buoyancy operated, depending on the difference in density between steam and condensate. The **float and thermostatic (F&T) trap** (Figure 10) is actually a combination of two types of traps in a single trap body: (1) a bellows thermostatic element operating on temperature difference, which provides automatic venting, and (2) a float portion, which is buoyancy operated. Float traps without automatic venting should not be used in steam systems.

On start-up, the float valve is closed and the thermostatic element is open for rapid air venting, permitting the system or equipment to rapidly fill with steam. When steam enters the trap body, the thermostatic element closes and, as condensate enters, the float rises and the condensate discharges. The float regulates the valve opening so it continuously discharges the condensate at the rate at which it reaches the trap.

The F&T trap has large venting capabilities, continuously discharges condensate without back-up, handles intermittent loads very well, and can operate at extremely low pressure differentials. Float and thermostatic traps are suited for use with temperature-regulated steam coils. They also are well suited for steam main and riser drip legs on low-pressure steam heating systems. Although F&T traps are available for pressures to 1700 kPa or higher, they are susceptible to water hammer, so other traps are usually a better choice for high-pressure applications.

Bucket traps operate on buoyancy, but they use a bucket that is either open at the top or inverted instead of a closed float. Initially, the bucket in an **open bucket trap** is empty and rests on the bottom of the trap body with the discharge vented, and, as condensate enters the trap, the bucket floats up and closes the discharge port. Additional condensate overflows into the bucket, causing it to sink and open the discharge port, which allows steam pressure to force the condensate out of the bucket. At the same time, it seals the bottom of the discharge tube, prohibiting air passage. Therefore, to prevent air binding, this device has an automatic air vent, as does the F&T trap. This trap does not allow for continuous air venting, and its construction is not as simple as the inverted bucket trap.

Inverted bucket traps eliminate the size and venting problems associated with open bucket traps. Steam or air entering the submerged inverted bucket causes it to float and close the discharge port. As more condensate enters the trap, it forces air and steam out of the vent on top of the inverted bucket into the trap body, where the steam condenses by cooling. When the mass of the bucket exceeds the buoyancy effect, the bucket drops, opening the discharge port, and steam pressure forces the condensate out, and the cycle repeats.

Unlike most cycling-type traps, the inverted bucket trap continuously vents air and noncondensable gases. Although it discharges condensate intermittently, there is no condensate back-up in a properly sized trap. Inverted bucket traps are made for all pressure ranges and are well suited for steam main drip legs and most HVAC applications, especially when condensate must be lifted to a return main above the equipment. Although inverted bucket traps can be used for temperature-regulated steam coils, the F&T trap is usually better because it has the high venting capability desirable for such applications.

Kinetic Traps

Numerous devices operate on the difference between the flow characteristics of steam and condensate and on the fact that condensate discharging to a lower pressure contains more heat than necessary to maintain the liquid phase. This excess heat causes some of the condensate to flash to steam at the lower pressure.

Thermodynamic traps or **disk traps** are simple devices with only one moving part. When air or condensate enters the trap on start-up, it lifts the disk off its seat and is discharged. When steam or hot condensate (some of which flashes to steam on exposure to a lower pressure) enters the trap, the increased velocity of this vapor flow decreases the pressure on the underside of the disk and increases the pressure above the disk, causing it to snap shut. Pressure is then equalized above and below the disk, but because the area exposed to pressure is greater above than below it, the disk remains shut until the pressure above is reduced by condensing or bleeding, thus allowing the disk to snap open and repeat the cycle. This device does not cycle open and shut as a function of condensate load; it is a time-cycle device that opens and shuts at fixed intervals as a function of how fast the steam above the disk condenses. Because disk traps require a significant pressure differential to operate properly, they are not well suited for low-pressure systems or for systems with significant back pressure. They are best suited for high-pressure systems and are widely applied to steam main drip legs.

Impulse traps or **piston traps** continuously pass a small amount of steam or condensate through a bleed orifice, changing the pressure positions within the piston. When live steam or very hot condensate that flashes to steam enters the control chamber, the increased pressure closes the piston valve port. When cooler condensate enters, the pressure decreases, allowing the valve port to open. Most impulse traps cycle open and shut intermittently, but some modulate to a position that passes condensate continuously.

Impulse traps can be used for the same applications as disk traps; however, because they have a small bleed orifice and close piston tolerances, they can stick or clog if dirt is present in the system.

Orifice traps have no moving parts. All other traps have discharge ports or orifices, but in the traps described previously, this opening is oversized, and some type of closing mechanism controls the flow of condensate and prevents the loss of live steam.

The orifice trap has no such closing mechanism, and the flow of steam and condensate is controlled by two-phase flow through an orifice. A simple explanation of this theory is that an orifice of any size has a much greater capacity for condensate than it does for steam because of the significant differences in their densities and because flashing condensate tends to choke the orifice. An orifice is selected larger than required for the actual condensate load; therefore, it continuously passes all condensate along with the air and noncondensable gases, plus a small, controlled amount of steam.

Orifice traps must be sized more carefully than cycling-type traps. On light condensate loads, the orifice size is small and, like impulse traps, tends to clog. Orifice traps are suitable for all system pressures and can operate against any back pressure. They are best suited for

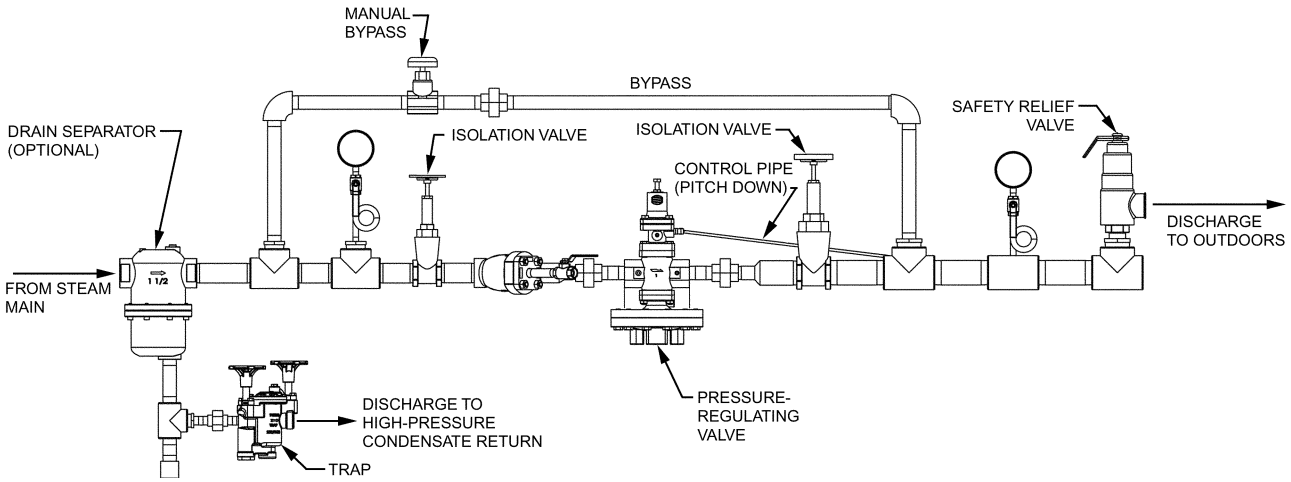

Fig. 11 Pressure-Reducing Valve Connections: Single-Stage

steady pressure and load conditions, but not recommended for applications with varying pressures or loads.

12. PRESSURE-REDUCING VALVES

Where steam is supplied at pressures higher than required, one or more pressure-reducing valves (pressure regulators) are required. The pressure-reducing valve reduces pressure to a safe point and regulates pressure to that required by the equipment. The district heating industry refers to valves according to their functional use. There are two classes of service: (1) the steam must be shut off completely (dead-end valves) to prevent build-up of pressure on the low-pressure side during no load (single-seated valves should be used) and (2) the low-pressure lines condense enough steam to prevent build-up of pressure from valve leakage (double-seated valves can be used). Valves available for either service are direct-operated, spring-loaded, mass-loaded, air-loaded, or pilot-controlled, using either the flowing steam or auxiliary air or water as the operating medium. The direct-operated, double-seated valve is less affected by varying inlet steam pressure than the direct-operated, single-seated valve. Pilot-controlled valves, either single- or double-seated, tend to eliminate the effect of variable inlet pressures.

Pilot-controlled or air-loaded direct-operated reducing valves can be used without limitation for all reduced-pressure settings for all heating, process, laundry, and hot-water services. Spring-loaded direct-operated valves can be used for reduced pressures up to 960 kPa (gage), providing they can pass the required steam flow without excessive deviation in reduced pressure.

The accuracy of control varies by regulator type. The direct-acting type controls to ±10% of set pressure, whereas pilot-controlled with a sensing line stays approximately ±1% of set-point pressure.

Pressure-equalizing or impulse lines must be connected to serve the type of valve selected. With direct-operated diaphragm valves having rubber-like diaphragms, connect the impulse line to the reduced-pressure steam line to allow for maximum condensate on the diaphragm and in the impulse or equalizing line. If it is connected to the top of the steam line, use a condensate accumulator to reduce variations in the pressure of condensate on the diaphragm. The impulse line should not be connected to the bottom of the reduced-pressure line, because it could become clogged. Equalizing or impulse lines for pilot-controlled and direct-operated reducing valves using metal diaphragms should be connected into the expanded outlet piping approximately 600 to 1200 mm from the reducing valve and pitched away from the reducing valve to prevent condensate accumulation. Install pressure impulse lines for externally pilot-controlled reducing valves using compressed air or fresh water according to manufacturer's recommendations.

Valve Size Selection

Size pressure-regulating valves to supply the maximum steam requirements of the heating system or equipment. Consider rangeability, speed of load changes, and regulation accuracy required to meet system needs, especially with temperature control systems using intermittent steam flow to heat the building.

Select the reducing valve carefully. Consult the manufacturer. Piping to and from the reducing valve should be adequate to pass the desired amount of steam at the desired maximum velocity. A common error is to make the size of the reducing valve the same as the service or outlet pipe size; this makes the reducing valve oversized and causes wiredrawing or erosion of the valve and seat because of the high-velocity flow caused by the small lift of the valve.

Installation

Pressure-reducing valves should be readily accessible for inspection and repair. There should be a bypass around each reducing valve equal to the area of the reducing-valve seat ring. The globe valve in a bypass line should have plug disk construction and must have an absolutely tight shutoff. Install steam pressure gages, graduated up to the initial pressure, on both the low- and high-pressure sides. The low-pressure gage should be ahead of the shutoff valve because the reducing valve can be adjusted with the shutoff valve closed. A similar gage should be installed downstream from the shutoff valve for use during manual operation. Typical service connections are shown in Figure 11 for single-stage pressure reduction applications.

Strainers should be installed on the inlet of the primary pressure-reducing valve and before the second-stage reduction if there is considerable piping between the two stages. If a two-stage reduction is made, it is advisable to install a pressure gage immediately before the reducing valve of the second-stage reduction to set and check the operation of the first valve. A drip trap should be installed before the two reducing valves.

Where pressure-reducing valves are used, one or more relief devices or safety valves must be provided, or equipment on the low-pressure side must meet the requirements for the full initial pressure. The relief or safety devices should be close to the reducing valve. The relieving capacity of the relief or safety device must be adequate to avoid exceeding the design pressure of the low-pressure system if the reducing valve fails in the open position. In

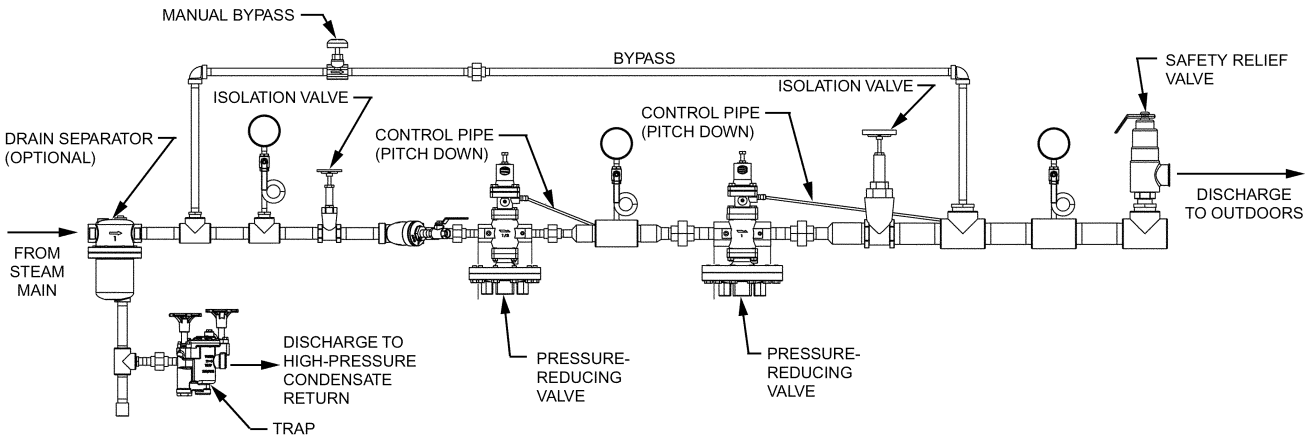

Fig. 12 Two-Stage Pressure-Reducing Valve

(Used where high-pressure steam is supplied for low-pressure requirements)

most areas, local codes dictate the safety relief valve installation requirements.

Safety valves should be set at least 35 kPa higher than the reduced pressure if the reduced pressure is under 240 kPa (gage) and at least 70 kPa higher than the reduced pressure if the reduced pressure is above 240 kPa (gage) or the first-stage reduction of a double reduction. The outlet from relief valves should not be piped to a location where the discharge can jeopardize persons or property or is a violation of local codes.

When making a two-stage reduction (e.g., 1000 to 140 kPa [gage] and then 140 to 14 kPa [gage]), allow for the expansion of steam on the low-pressure side of each reducing valve by increasing the pipe size to keep velocity at an acceptable level. Recommended velocities are30 to 40 m/s for low pressures and 40 to 50 m/s for higher pressures.This also allows steam to flow at a more uniform velocity. It is recommended that the valves be separated by a distance of at least 6 m to reduce excessive hunting action of the first valve, although this should be checked with the valve manufacturer.

Figure 12 shows a typical double-reduction installation where pressure in the district steam main is higher than can safely be applied to building heating systems. The first pressure-reducing valve provides the initial pressure reduction. The second pressure-reducing valve regulates the steam to the desired final pressure.

On installations where the steam requirements are large and variable, wiredrawing and cycling control can occur during mild weather or during reduced demand periods. To overcome this condition, install two reducing valves in parallel, with the sizes selected on a 70 and 30% proportion of maximum flow. For example, if 1000 kW of steam are required, the size of one valve is based on 700 kW of steam, and the other is based on 300 kW of steam.

During mild weather (spring and fall), the larger valve is set for slightly lower reduced pressure than the smaller one and remains closed as long as the smaller one can meet the demand. For example, if required downstream system pressure is 103 kPa (gage), the smaller valve would be set at 110 kPa (gage) and the larger valve at 96 kPa (gage). During the remainder of the heating season, the valve settings are reversed to keep the smaller one closed, except when the larger one is unable to meet the demand.The relief valve should be sized based on the highest set pressure. The safety relief valve should be sized to handle the combined maximum capacity of both valves. This type of installation is often referred to as a one-third/two-thirds reduction, and is shown in Figure 13.

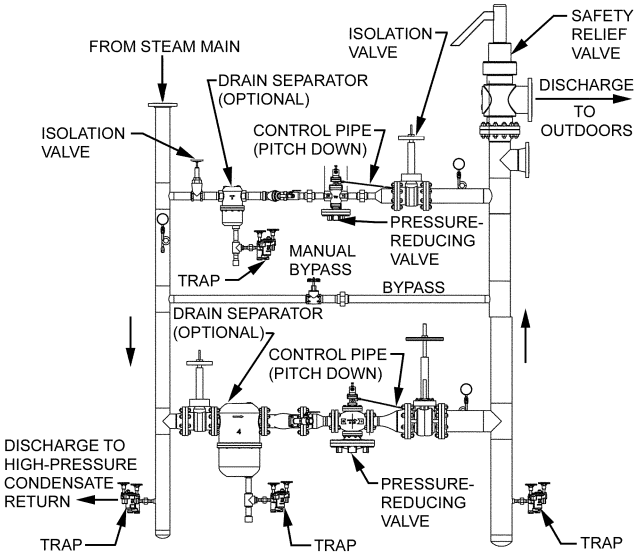

Fig. 13 One-Third/Two-Thirds Pressure-Reducing Valve Station

(Used where large and variable steam demands occur)

13. TERMINAL EQUIPMENT

Various terminal units are used in steam heating systems. All are suited for use on low-pressure systems. Terminal units used on high-pressure systems have heavier construction, but are otherwise similar to those on low-pressure systems. Terminal units are usually classified as follows:

1. **Natural convection units** transfer most heat by convection and some heat by radiation. The equipment includes cast-iron radiators, finned-tube convectors, and cabinet and baseboard units with convection-type elements (see Chapter 36).
2. **Forced-convection units** employ a forced air movement to increase heat transfer and distribute the heated air within the space. The devices include unit heaters, unit ventilators, induction units, fan-coil units, the heating coils of central air-conditioning units, and many process heat exchangers. When such units are used for both heating and cooling, there is a steam coil for heating

and a separate chilled water or refrigerant coil for cooling. See Chapters 1, 3, 4, 5, 23, 27, and 28.

3. **Radiant panel systems** transfer some heat by convection. Because of the low-temperature and high-vacuum requirements, this type of unit is rarely used on steam systems.

Selection

The primary consideration in selecting terminal equipment is comfortable heat distribution. The following briefly describes suitable applications for specific types of steam terminal units.

Natural Convection Units

Radiators, convectors, convection-type cabinet units, and baseboard convectors are commonly used for (1) facilities that require heating only, rather than both heating and cooling, and (2) in conjunction with central air conditioning as a source of perimeter heating or for localized heating in spaces such as corridors, entrances, halls, toilets, kitchens, and storage areas.

Forced-Convection Units

Forced-convection units can be used for the same types of applications as natural convection units but are primarily used for facilities that require both heating and cooling, as well as spaces that require localized heating.

Unit heaters are often used as the primary source of heat in factories, warehouses, and garages and as supplemental freeze protection for loading ramps, entrances, equipment rooms, and fresh air plenums.

Unit ventilators are forced-convection units with dampers that introduce controlled amounts of outdoor air. They are used in spaces with ventilation requirements not met by other system components.

Cabinet heaters are often used in entranceways and vestibules that can have high intermittent heat loads.

Induction units are similar to fan-coil units, but the air is supplied by a central air system rather than individual fans in each unit. Induction units are most commonly used as perimeter heating for facilities with central systems.

Fan-coil units are designed for heating and cooling. On water systems, a single coil can be supplied with hot water for heating and chilled water for cooling. On steam systems, single- or dual-coil units can be used. Single-coil units require steam-to-water heat exchangers to provide hot water to meet heating requirements. Dual-coil units have a steam coil for heating and a separate coil for cooling. The cooling media for dual-coil units can be chilled water from a central chiller or refrigerant provided by a self-contained compressor. Single-coil units require the entire system to be either in a heating or cooling mode and do not allow simultaneous heating and cooling to satisfy individual space requirements. Dual-coil units can eliminate this problem.

Central air-handling units are used for most larger facilities. These units have a fan, a heating and cooling coil, and a compressor if chilled water is not available for cooling. Multizone units are arranged so that each air outlet has separate controls for individual space heating or cooling requirements. Large central systems distribute either warm or cold conditioned air through duct systems and use separate terminal equipment such as mixing boxes, reheat coils, or variable-volume controls to control the temperature to satisfy each space. Central air-handling systems can be factory assembled, field erected, or built at the job site from individual components.

14. CONVECTION STEAM HEATING

Any system that uses steam as the heat transfer medium can be considered a steam heating system; however, the term "steam heating system" is most commonly applied to convection systems using radiators or convectors as terminal equipment. Other types of steam heating systems use forced convection, in which a fan or air-handling system is used with a convector or steam coil such as unit heaters, fan-coil units, and central air-conditioning and heating systems.

Convection-type steam heating systems are used in facilities that have a heating requirement only, such as factories, warehouses, and apartment buildings. They are often used in conjunction with central air-conditioning systems to heat the perimeter of the building. Also, steam is commonly used with incremental units that are designed for cooling and heating and have a self-contained air-conditioning compressor.

Steam heating systems are classified as one-pipe or two-pipe systems, according to the piping arrangement that supplies steam to and returns condensate from the terminal equipment. These systems can be further subdivided by (1) the method of condensate return (gravity flow or mechanical flow by means of condensate pump or vacuum pump) and (2) by the piping arrangement (upfeed or downfeed and parallel or counterflow for one-pipe systems).

One-Pipe Steam Heating Systems

The one-pipe system has a single pipe through which steam flows to and condensate is returned from the terminal equipment (Figure 14). These systems are designed as gravity return, although a condensate pump can be used where there is insufficient height above the boiler water level to develop enough pressure to return condensate directly to the boiler.

A one-pipe system with gravity return does not have steam traps; instead it has air vents at each terminal unit and at the ends of all supply mains to vent the air so the system can fill with steam. In a system with a condensate pump, there must be an air vent at each terminal unit and steam traps at the ends of each supply main.

The one-pipe system with gravity return has low initial cost and is simple to install, because it requires a minimum of mechanical equipment and piping. One-pipe systems are most commonly used in small facilities such as small apartment buildings and office buildings. In larger facilities, the larger pipe sizes required for two-phase flow, problems of distributing steam quickly and evenly throughout the system, the inability to zone the system, and difficulty in controlling the temperature make the one-pipe system less desirable than the two-pipe system.

Heat input to the system is controlled by cycling the steam on and off. In the past, temperature control in individual spaces has been a problem. Many systems have adjustable vents at each terminal unit to help balance the system, but these are seldom effective. A practical approach is to use a self-contained thermostatic valve in series with the air vent (as explained in the section on Temperature Control) that provides limited individual thermostatic control for each space.

Many designers do not favor one-pipe systems because of their distribution and control problems. However, when a self-contained thermostatic valve is used to eliminate the problems, one-pipe sys-

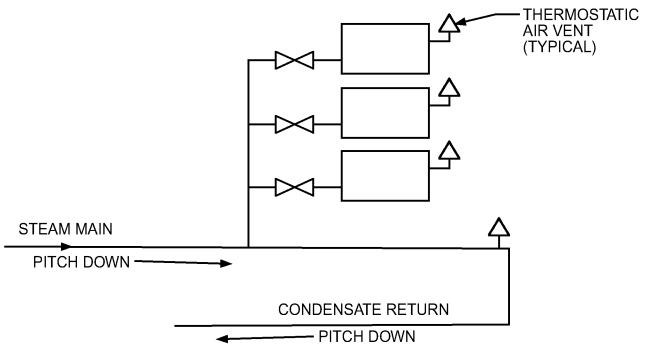

Fig. 14 One-Pipe System

tems can be considered for small facilities, where initial cost and simple installation and operation are prime factors.

Most one-pipe gravity return systems are in facilities that have their own boiler, and, because returning condensate must overcome boiler pressure, these systems usually operate to a maximum of 35 kPa (gage). The boiler hookup is critical and the Hartford loop (described in the section on Boiler Connections) is used to avoid problems that can occur with boiler low-water condition. Hoffman (1969) and Stamper and Koral (1979) give piping design information for one-pipe systems.

Two-Pipe Steam Heating Systems

The two-pipe system uses separate pipes to deliver the steam and return the condensate from each terminal unit (Figure 15). Thermostatic traps are installed at the outlet of each terminal unit to keep steam in the unit until it gives up its latent heat, at which time the trap cycles open to pass the condensate and allows more steam to enter the radiator. If orifices are installed at the inlet to each terminal unit, as discussed in the sections on Steam Distribution and Temperature Control, and if the system pressure is precisely regulated so only the amount of steam is delivered to each unit that it is capable of condensing, the steam traps can be omitted. However, omitting steam traps is generally not recommended

Two-pipe systems can have either gravity or mechanical returns; however, gravity returns are restricted to use in small systems and are generally outmoded. In larger systems that require higher steam pressures to distribute steam, some mechanical means, such as a condensate pump or vacuum pump, must return condensate to the boiler. In a large system that does not use a condensate pump or vacuum pump, a large volume of air filling the steam distribution pipes would cause a delay in condensate return to the boiler. As steam continues to leave the boiler, a low-water condition would occur and an automatic feed pump would be required to provide additional water to the boiler. After the steam pushes the air out of the distribution system, the volume of water inside the boiler is too high, causing the boiler to flood. To avoid this issue, a **vacuum return system** is used on larger systems, where vacuum pumps remove air from the condensate return pipes, facilitating the return of the condensate to the boiler. A vacuum return system has the following advantages:

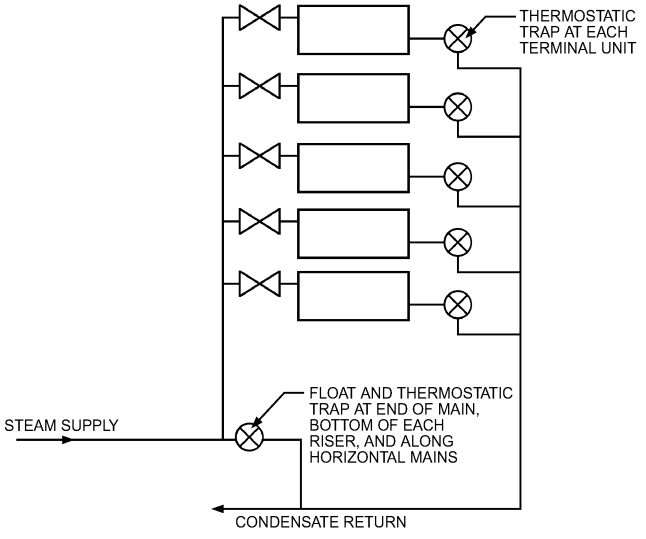

Fig. 15 Two-Pipe System

- Removal of air from the return pipes allows the condensate to return to the boiler faster, which prevents flooding the boiler and allows for a faster heating cycle.
- The steam supply pressure can be lower, resulting in more efficient operation.

Variable vacuum or subatmospheric systems are a variation of the vacuum return system in which a controllable vacuum is maintained in both the supply and return sides. This allows using the lowest possible system temperature and prompt steam distribution to the terminal units. The primary purpose of variable vacuum systems is to control temperature, as discussed in the section on Temperature Control.

Unlike one-pipe systems, two-pipe systems can be simply zoned where piping is arranged to supply heat to individual sections of the building that have similar heating requirements. Heat is supplied to meet the requirements of each section without overheating other sections. Heat also can be varied according to factors such as the hours of use, type of occupancy, and sun load.

15. STEAM DISTRIBUTION

Steam supply piping should be sized so that the pressure drops in all branches of the same supply main are nearly uniform. Return piping should be sized for the same pressure drop as supply piping for quick and even steam distribution. Because it is impossible to size piping so that pressure drops are exactly the same, the steam flows first to those units that can be reached with the least resistance, resulting in uneven heating. Units farthest from the source of steam heat last, while other spaces are overheated. This problem is most evident when the system is filling with steam. It can be severe on systems in which temperature is controlled by cycling the steam on and off. The problem can be alleviated or eliminated by balancing valves or inlet orifices. If the steam is not cycled on and off, a thermostatic valve on the inlet of each unit maintains a fairly constant temperature.

Balancing valves are installed at the unit inlet and contain an adjustable valve port to control the amount of steam delivered. The main problem with such devices is that they are seldom calibrated accurately, so that variations in orifice size as small as 1.9 mm^2 can make a significant difference.

Inlet orifices are thin brass or copper plates installed in the unit inlet valve or pipe unions (Figure 16). Inlet orifices can solve distribution problems, because they can be drilled for appropriate size and changed easily to compensate for unusual conditions. Properly sized inlet orifices can compensate for oversized heating units, reduce energy waste and system control problems caused by excessive steam loss from defective steam traps, and provide a means of temperature control and balancing within individual zones. Manufacturers of orifice plates provide data for calculating the required sizes for most systems. Also, Sanford and Sprenger (1931) developed data for sizing orifices for low-pressure, gravity return sys-

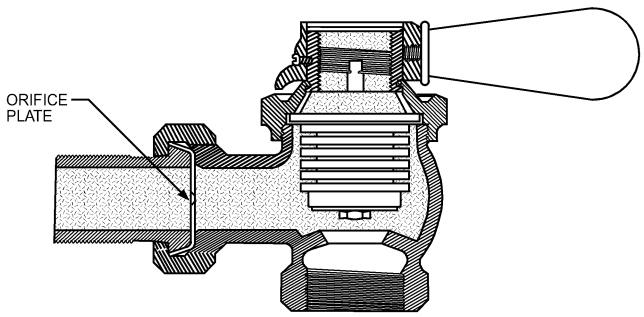

Fig. 16 Inlet Orifice

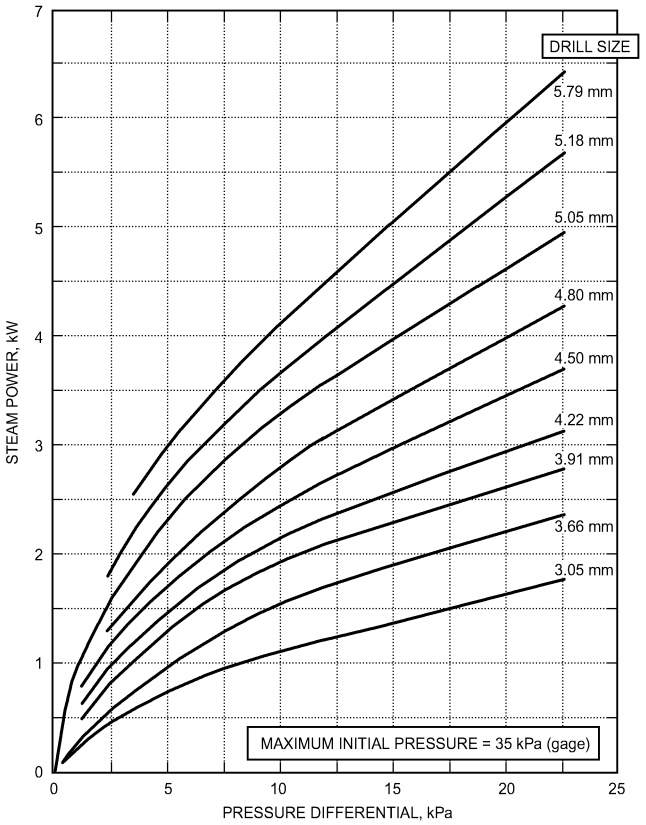

Fig. 17 Orifice Capacities for Different Pressure Differentials

(Schroeder 1950)

tems. See Figure 17 for capacities of orifices at various pressure differentials.

If orifices are installed in valves or pipe unions that are conveniently accessible, minor rebalancing among individual zones can be accomplished through replacement of individual orifices.

16. TEMPERATURE CONTROL

All heating systems require some means of temperature control to achieve the desired comfort conditions and operating efficiencies. In convection-type steam heating systems, the temperature and resulting heat output of the terminal units must be increased or decreased. This can be done by (1) permitting the steam to enter the heating unit intermittently, (2) varying the steam temperature delivered to each unit, and (3) varying the amount of steam delivered to each unit.

There are two types of controls: those that control the temperature or heat input to the entire system and those that control the temperature of individual spaces or zones. Often, both types are used together for maximum control and operating efficiency.

Intermittent flow controls, commonly called **heat timers**, control the temperature of the system by cycling the steam on and off during a certain portion (or fraction) of each hour as a function of the outdoor and/or indoor temperature. Most of these devices provide for night setback, and computerized or electronic models optimize morning start-up as a function of outdoor and indoor temperature and make anticipatory adjustments. Used independently, these devices do not allow varying heat input to different parts of the building or spaces, so they should be used with zone control valves or individual thermostatic valves for maximum energy efficiency. Feedback from occupied space can be obtained by using space sensors to delay the on cycle when indoor thermal conditions allow. Space sensors can be wired or wireless types to communicate with a central controller. Sensors should be installed in multiple locations to provide proper feedback of thermal conditions in occupied spaces. In an apartment building, the number of sensors is typically between 10 and 15% of the total number of apartments.

Zone control valves control the temperature of spaces with similar heating requirements as a function of outdoor and/or indoor temperature, allow duty cycling. These intermittent flow control devices operate fully open or fully closed. They are controlled by an indoor thermostat and are used in conjunction with a heat timer, variable vacuum, or pressure differential control that controls heat input to the system.

Individual thermostatic valves installed at each terminal unit can provide the proper amount of heat to satisfy each space's individual requirements and eliminate overheating. Valves can be actuated electrically, pneumatically, or by a self-contained mechanism that has a wax- or liquid-filled sensing element requiring no external power source.

Individual thermostatic valves can be and are often used as the only means of temperature control. However, these systems are always "on," resulting in inefficiency and no central control of heat input to the system or to the individual zones. Electronic, electric, and pneumatic operators allow centralized control to be built into the system. However, it is desirable to have a supplemental system control with self-contained thermostatic valves in the form of zone control valves, or a system that controls the heat input to the entire system, relying on self-contained valves as a local high-temperature shutoff only.

Self-contained thermostatic valves can also be used to control temperature on one-pipe systems that cycle on and off when installed in series with the unit air vent. On initial start-up, the air vent is open, and inherent system distribution problems still exist. However, on subsequent on-cycles where the room temperature satisfies the thermostatic element, the vent valve remains closed, preventing the unit from filling with steam.

Variable vacuum or subatmospheric systems control the temperature of the system by varying the steam temperature through pressure control. These systems differ from the regular vacuum return system in that the vacuum is maintained in both supply and return lines. Such systems usually operate at a pressure range from 15 kPa above to 85 kPa below atmospheric pressure. Inlet orifices are installed at the terminal equipment for proper steam distribution during mild weather.

Design-day conditions are seldom encountered, so the system usually operates at a substantial vacuum. Because the specific volume of steam increases as the pressure decreases, it takes less steam to fill the system and operating efficiency results. The variable vacuum system can be used in conjunction with zone control valves or individual self-contained valves for increased operating efficiency.

Pressure differential control (two-pipe orifice) systems provide centralized temperature control with any system that has properly sized inlet orifices at each heating unit. This method operates on the principle that flow through an orifice is a function of the pressure differential across the orifice plate. The pressure range is selected to fill each heating unit on the coldest design day; on warmer days, the supply pressure is lowered so that heating units are only partially filled with steam, thereby reducing their heat output. An advantage of this method is that it virtually eliminates all heating unit steam trap losses because the heating units are only partially filled with steam on all but the coldest design days.

The required system pressure differential can be achieved manually with throttling valves or with an automatic pressure differential controller. Table 3 shows the required pressure differentials to maintain 21°C indoors for –18°C outdoor design, with orifices according to Figure 17. Required pressure differential curves can be

Table 3 Pressure Differential Temperature Control

Outdoor Temperature, °C	Required Pressure Differential,* kPa
–15	17.7
–10	13.5
–5	9.7
0	6.5
5	3.8
10	1.7
15	0.5

*To maintain 21°C indoors for –18°C outdoor design.

established for any combination of supply and return line pressures by sizing orifices to deliver the proper amount of steam for the coldest design day, calculating the amount of steam required for warmer days using Equation (3), and then selecting the pressure differential that will provide this flow rate.

$$Q_r = Q_d \frac{(t_i)_{design} - t_o}{(t_i)_{design} - (t_o)_{design}} \quad (3)$$

where

Q_r = required flow rate
Q_d = design day flow rate
$(t_i)_{design}$ = design indoor temperature
$(t_o)_{design}$ = design outdoor temperature
t_o = outdoor temperature

Pressure differential systems can be used with zone control valves or individual self-contained thermostatic valves to increase operating efficiency.

17. HEAT RECOVERY

Two methods are generally used to recover heat from condensate: (1) the enthalpy of the liquid condensate (sensible heat) can be used to vaporize (flash) some of the liquid to steam at a lower pressure, or (2) it can be used directly in a heat exchanger to heat air, fluid, or a process.

The particular methods used vary with the type of system. As explained in the section on Basic Steam System Design, facilities that purchase steam from a utility generally do not have to return condensate and, therefore, can recover heat to the maximum extent possible. On the other hand, facilities with their own boiler generally want the condensate to return to the boiler as hot as possible, limiting heat recovery because any heat removed from condensate has to be returned to the boiler to generate steam again.

Flash Steam

Flash steam is an effective use for the enthalpy of the liquid condensate. It can be used in any facility that has a requirement for steam at different pressures, regardless of whether steam is purchased or generated by a facility's own boiler. Flash steam can be used in any heat exchange device to heat air, water, or other liquids or directly in processes with lower-pressure steam requirements. Equation (1) may be used to calculate the amount of flash steam generated, and Figure 18 provides a graph for calculating the amount of flash steam as a function of system pressures.

Although flash steam can be generated directly by discharging high-pressure condensate to a lower-pressure system, most designers prefer a **flash tank** to control flashing. Flash tanks can be mounted either vertically or horizontally, but the vertical arrangement shown in Figure 19 is preferred because it provides better separation of steam and water, resulting in the highest possible steam quality.

The most important dimension in the design of vertical flash tanks is the internal diameter, which must be large enough to ensure

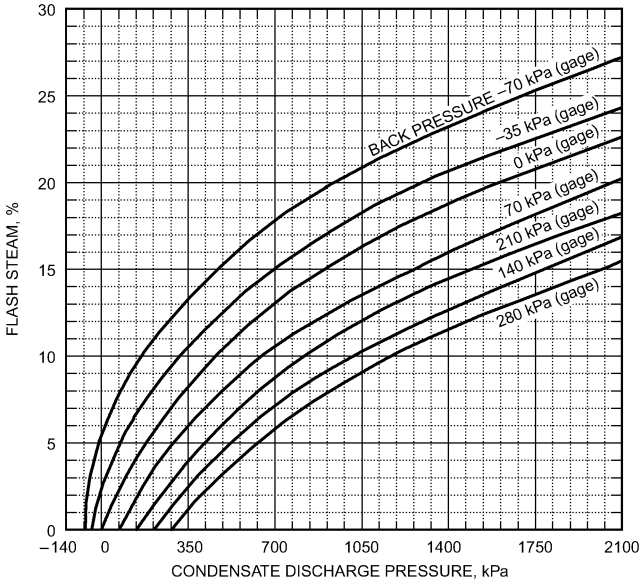

Fig. 18 Flash Steam

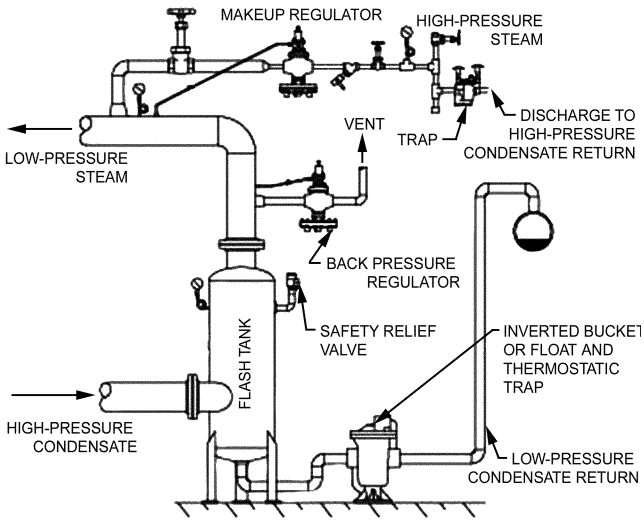

Fig. 19 Vertical Flash Tank

velocity is low enough, the height of the tank is not important, but it is good practice to use a height of at least 600 to 900 mm. The graph in Figure 20 can be used to determine the internal diameter and is based on a steam velocity of 3 m/s, which is the maximum velocity in most systems.

Installation is important for proper flash tank operation. Condensate lines should pitch towards the flash tank. If more than one condensate line discharges to the tank, each line should be equipped with a swing check valve to prevent backflow. Condensate lines and the flash tank should be well insulated to prevent any unnecessary heat loss. Install a thermostatic air vent at the top of the tank to vent any air that accumulates. The tank should be trapped at the bottom with an inverted bucket or float and thermostatic trap. The trap should be sized to three times the condensate load.

The demand load should always be greater than the amount of flash steam available to prevent the low-pressure system from becoming overpressurized. It is recommended to install a back pressure regulator to maintain a constant pressure in the tank

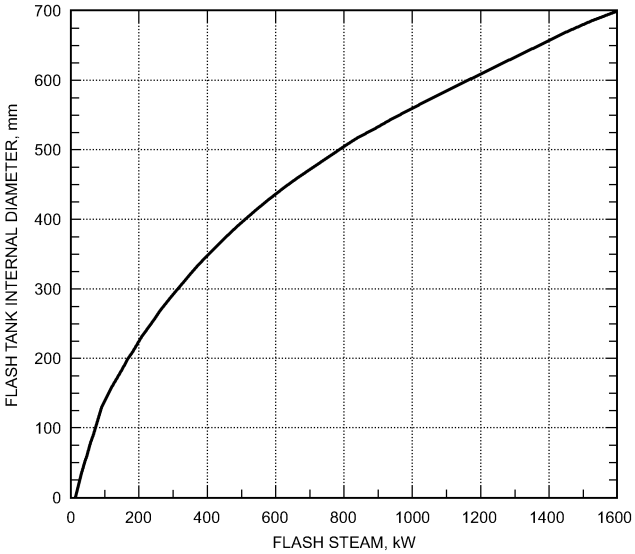

Fig. 20 Flash Tank Diameters

should the flash steam exceed the demand load. Because the flash steam available is generally less than the demand for low-pressure steam, a makeup valve ensures that the low-pressure system maintains design pressure. The back-pressure regulator should be set at a pressure slightly higher than the low-pressure system's operating pressure. A back-pressure regulator should never be used as a safety device, so a safety relief valve should also be installed on the flash tank to protect the low-pressure equipment. (See Figure 19 for a typical flash tank arrangement.) An example of set pressures might be makeup valve set at 100 kPa (gage), back-pressure regulator set at 120 kPa (gage), and safety relief valve on the flash tank set at 140 kPa (gage).

Flash tanks are considered pressure vessels and must be constructed in accordance with ASME and local codes.

Direct Heat Recovery

Direct heat recovery that uses the liquid's enthalpy in some type of heat exchange device is appropriate when condensate is not returned to a facility's own boiler; any lowering of condensate temperature below saturation temperature requires reheating at the boiler to regenerate steam.

Enthalpy of the condensate can be used in fan-coil units, unit heaters, or convectors to heat spaces where temperature control is not critical, such as garages, ramps, loading docks, and entrance halls, or in a shell-and-tube heat exchanger to heat water or other fluids.

In most HVAC applications, the enthalpy of the liquid condensate may be used most effectively and efficiently to heat domestic hot water with a shell-and-tube or plate-type heat exchanger, commonly called an economizer. Many existing economizers do not use the enthalpy of the condensate effectively because they are designed only to preheat makeup water flowing directly through the heat exchanger at the time of water use. Hot-water use seldom coincides with condensate load, and most of the enthalpy is wasted in these preheat economizer systems.

A storage-type water heater can be effectively used for heat recovery. This can be a shell-and-tube heat exchanger with a condensate coil for heat recovery and a steam or electric coil when the condensate enthalpy cannot satisfy the demand. Another option is a storage-type heat exchanger incorporating only a coil for condensate with a supplemental heat exchanger to satisfy peak loads. Note that many areas require a double-wall heat exchanger between steam and the potable water.

Chapter 51 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* provides useful information on determining hot-water loads for various facilities. In general, however, the following provide optimum heat recovery:

- Install the greatest storage capacity in the available space. Although all systems must have supplemental heaters for peak load conditions, with ample storage capacity these heaters may seldom function if all the necessary heat is provided by the enthalpy of the condensate.
- For maximum recovery, allow stored water to heat to 82°C or higher, using a mixing valve to temper the water to the proper delivery temperature.

18. COMBINED STEAM AND WATER SYSTEMS

Combined steam and water systems are often used to take advantage of the unique properties of steam, which are described in the sections on Advantages and Fundamentals.

Combined systems are used where a facility must generate steam to satisfy the heating requirements of certain processes or equipment. They are usually used where steam is available from a utility and economic considerations of local codes preclude the facility from operating its own boiler plant. There are two types of combined steam and water systems: (1) steam used directly as a heating medium, for which the terminal equipment must have two separate coils, one for heating with steam and one for cooling with chilled water; and (2) steam used indirectly and piped to heat exchangers that generate the hot water for use at terminal equipment; the exchanger for terminal equipment may use either one coil or separate coils for heating and cooling.

Combined steam and water systems may be two-, three-, or four-pipe systems. Chapters 3 and 5 have further descriptions.

19. COMMISSIONING

After design and construction of a system, care should be taken to ensure correct performance of the system and that building personnel understand the operating and maintenance procedure required to maintain operating efficiency. Ongoing commissioning is required to identify malfunctioning steam traps, which must be fixed or replaced to prevent water hammer, reduce energy consumption, prevent thermal discomfort, and protect equipment from damage. It should also evaluate the steam system's operating pressure to ensure that the steam boiler operates at the minimum possible supply pressure. Incorporating a water meter into the boiler feedwater system allows for continuously identifying excessive water feed, which is related to water leakage or dumping of condensate, and hence reduces both water and energy consumption.

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CHAPTER 12

DISTRICT HEATING AND COOLING

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DISTRICT heating and cooling (DHC) or district energy (DE) distributes thermal energy from a central source to residential, commercial, and/or industrial consumers for use in space heating, cooling, water heating, and/or process heating. The energy is distributed by steam or hot- or chilled-water lines. Thus, thermal energy comes from a distribution medium rather than being generated on site at each facility.

Systems may also operate as a source or sink for both heating and cooling loads with distribution system temperatures near ambient. According to Pierce (1994), district heating was proposed in 1613 in London; however, the first known examples were hot-water systems installed in St. Petersburg, Russia, in the 1840s. In the United States, the first district heating system was installed at the Naval Academy in Annapolis, Maryland, in 1853. Birdsell Holly is often credited with inventing district heating in Lockport, New York, in 1877, but he was simply the first to make it a commercial enterprise, ultimately expanding it to other cities. Most major U.S. cities soon were served by steam-based district heating systems; the majority of those systems still survive today, the largest in New York City. Although steam systems were also built in a number of major European cites, hot-water-based district heating saw significant growth in Europe, in part because of the reconstruction after World War II and the construction or expansion of many U.S. military bases, which were an ideal application for district heating. Both steam and high-temperature hot-water systems were built on bases. In Europe, especially Scandinavia, hot-water-based district heating systems adopted low temperatures for supply; that trend continues today, with systems using supply temperatures of 70°C or lower.

Early attempts at district cooling date back to the 1880s (Pierce 1994). By the 1930s, commercial systems were being built. Although recent development in district cooling had been confined mostly to the United States, there has been increased international activity, notably in the Middle East and in Europe. The International District Energy Association (IDEA) represents both heating and cooling utilities and reported that approximately 86% of the conditioned building space added in the last six years by its member systems was added outside of the United States; the vast majority of that growth was district cooling development in the Middle East (IDEA 2008a).

Whether the system is a public utility or user owned, such as a multibuilding campus, it has economic and environmental benefits depending somewhat on the particular application. Political feasibility must be considered, particularly if a municipality or governmental body is considering a DHC installation. Historically, successful DHC systems have had the political backing and support of the community. IDEA (2008a) has many applicable suggestions in developing and designing district cooling systems.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.2, District Energy.

Applicability

District heating and cooling systems are best used in markets where (1) the thermal load density is high and (2) the annual load factor or operating hours are high. A high load density is needed to cover the capital investment for the transmission and distribution system, which usually constitutes a significant portion of the capital cost for the overall system, often amounting to 50% or more of the total cost for district heating systems (normally lower for district cooling applications). Where distribution systems operate near ambient temperatures, insulated piping may not be required; thus lower load densities as well as both heating and cooling loads may be economically served.

The annual load factor is important because the total system is capital intensive. These factors make district heating and cooling systems most attractive in serving (1) industrial complexes, (2) densely populated urban areas, and (3) high-density building clusters with high thermal loads such as mixed-use developments, airports, college and university campuses, and large office developments. Low-density residential areas have usually not been attractive markets for district heating, although there have been many successful applications in Scandinavia using low-temperature hot water (Zinko et al. 2008). District heating is best suited to areas with a high building and population density in relatively cold climates; however, using absorption chillers can also provide summer load for systems operating with high-enough water supply temperatures or steam pressures. District cooling applies in most areas that have appreciable concentrations of cooling loads, usually associated with taller buildings and mixed use developments. For information on business models and business development for district cooling enterprises, see IDEA (2008a).

Components

Historically, district heating and cooling systems consist of three primary components: the central plant, the distribution network, and the consumer systems (Figure 1).

The **central source** or **production plant** may be any type of boiler; a refuse incinerator; a geothermal heat source; solar energy; heat pump with heat sourced from sewage, seawater, groundwater, ground coupling, surface water, or waste heat; or thermal energy developed as a by-product of electrical generation. The last approach, called combined heat and power (CHP), has a high energy utilization efficiency; see Chapter 7 for information on CHP. Recently interest has grown in systems where the distribution medium temperature is near ambient temperature. Heat pumps are normally used within individual buildings to boost the near-ambient temperatures to lev-

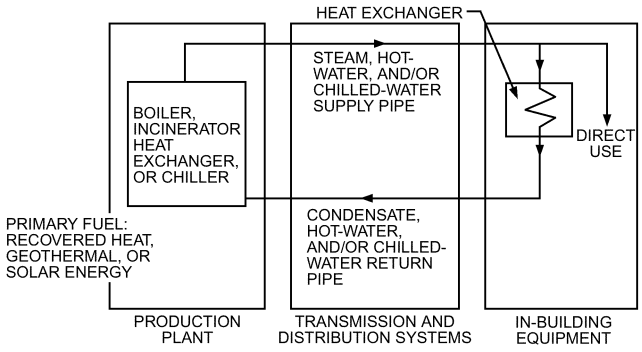


Fig. 1 Major Components of District Heating System

els suitable for space and domestic hot water heating. Heat pumps in individual buildings may also be used to generate space cooling. These systems may not have central plants per se but may include geothermal sources/sinks (see Chapter 35 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*).

Chilled water can be produced by

- Absorption refrigeration machines
- Electric-driven compression equipment (reciprocating, rotary screw or centrifugal chillers)
- Gas/steam turbine- or engine-driven compression equipment
- Combination of mechanically driven systems and thermal-energy-driven absorption systems (**hybrid systems**)

The second component is the **distribution** or **piping network** that conveys the energy. The piping is often the most expensive portion of a district heating or cooling system. The piping usually consists of a combination of preinsulated and field-insulated pipe in both concrete tunnel and direct burial applications. These networks require substantial permitting and coordinating with nonusers of the system for right-of-way if not on the owner's property. Because the initial cost is high in distribution systems, it is important to optimize its use.

The third component is the **consumer system**, which includes connections to the in-building equipment. When steam is supplied, it may be (1) used directly for heating; (2) directed through a pressure-reducing station for use in low-pressure (0 to 100 kPa) steam space heating, service water heating, humidification, and absorption cooling; or (3) passed through a steam-to-water heat exchanger. When hot or chilled water is supplied, it may be used directly by the building HVAC systems or indirectly where isolated by a heat exchanger (see the section on Consumer Interconnections).

Environmental Benefits

Generating thermal energy from a central plant is normally more efficient than using in-building equipment (i.e., a decentralized approach) and thus reduces environmental impacts. The greater efficiencies arise because of the larger, more efficient equipment and the ability to stage that equipment to closely match the load yet remain within the equipment's range of highest efficiency. District energy plants also take advantage of diversity of demand across all users in the system, and may also implement some technologies (e.g., thermal storage) more readily than decentralized systems. Furthermore, district heating and cooling may use heat sources and sinks that, due to their characteristics, would be difficult for individual building equipment to use (e.g., seawater, sewage, industrial process waste streams).

Emissions from central plants are easier to control than those from individual plants and, in aggregate, are lower because of higher-quality equipment, seasonal efficiencies, level of maintenance, load diversity, and lower system heat loss. Technologies such as carbon capture may also be applied on a district scale where it is not feasible for individual buildings. Although today's political climate may not perceive new coal plants as desirable, existing central plants that burn coal can economically remove noxious sulfur emissions, where removal with individual combustors would not be cost effective. Furthermore, solid-fuel boilers also can burn other waste products, including biomass fuels and refuse. Similarly, the thermal energy and gaseous waste from municipal wastes can provide an environmentally sound system. Cogeneration of heat and electric power allows for combined efficiencies of energy use that greatly reduce emissions, decrease energy used, and allow for fuel flexibility. In addition, refrigerants can be monitored and controlled more readily in a central plant. Where site conditions allow, remote location of the plant reduces many of the concerns with use of any more hazardous compounds such as ammonia for cooling systems.

1. SYSTEM MASTER PLANNING

Planning a "green field" district energy system or mapping out growth scenarios for an existing system takes a great deal of effort in gathering information regarding not only the customer base, but also plant sites, distribution routing, fuel sources and sensitivities, levels of redundancy, etc. This planning phase is typically referred to as **master planning**. Master plans take a long-term view of system development and growth, investigating many parameters and potential road blocks to development and growth. For a more complete explanation of the master planning process, see Chapter 2 of Phetteplace et al. (2019) or Phetteplace et al. (2013).

At a minimum, a master plan should provide a prioritized program for long-term guidance for building, expanding, and upgrading the district systems, which are typically built incrementally. A good master plan serves as a technically sound marketing tool for the owner's engineers to present needs and solutions to management or to prospective customers. Unfortunately, many owners view utility master plans as an interesting technical exercise with a life of one or two years. When this has been an owner's experience, it is usually because of at least one of the following reasons:

- Failure to involve the owner's staff
- Failure to provide intermediate owner reviews
- Use of an unverified database
- Lack of creativity in developing technically sound system alternatives for screening and final selection by the owner
- Inaccurate cost estimation, often related to overly optimistic estimation using unit costs that do not include all elements of the systems

The process for developing a master plan may be likened to a pyramid (Figure 2) (Bahnfleth 2004). The success of the plan depends on the foundation: a strong, accurate database that includes discovery and verification. All other aspects of a master plan stand on this basis and get their credibility from it. With the database in place, alternatives are identified and the preliminary estimates of cost (screening grade) for each option are used to work with the owner to select the most promising choices. These selections are then subjected to more intense analysis before making the final decisions of how the new plant (or expansion of an existing plant) will be developed, as well as how plans for future projects will be laid out. Thus, the pinnacle of the pyramid is a prioritized, priced list of projects needed to both keep pace with the physical growth of a facility or district and to provide replacements and upgrades to the existing system, if there is one.

Typical technical issues addressed in master plans include the following:

- Code and regulator implications
- Phases of development and construction
- Other uses of thermal energy (i.e., absorption chiller for steam system summer use)
- Planned growth of system and potential of building use change

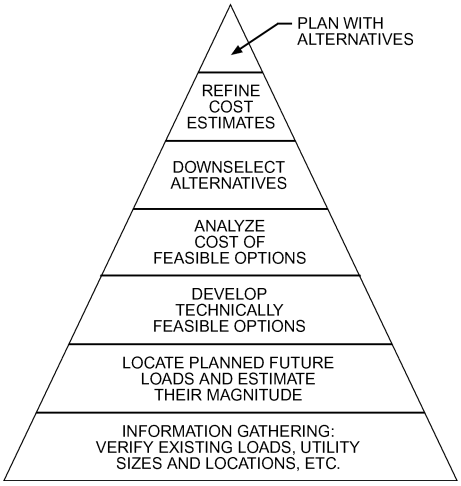


Fig. 2 Master Planning Pyramid

(Bahnfleth 2004)

- Siting of central plant (noise issues, survivability during severe weather event, flooding, aesthetics)
- Topography
- Fuel availability, days of on-site storage, fuel handling, and cost
- Equipment selection (chillers, boilers, cooling towers, etc.)
- Distribution system routing and material selection
- Heating and cooling medium options (system temperatures and pressures)
- Type of consumer interconnection (direct or indirect)
- Metering technology and invoicing scheme

It is recommended that an experienced planner and designer of district heating/cooling be consulted in the early planning phase if those undertaking the master plan and design do not have wide experience with district cooling systems (DCSs).

1.1 ECONOMIC CONSIDERATIONS

Consumer Economics

A district heating and cooling system offers many economic benefits. Even though the basic costs are still borne by the district energy provider (central plant owner/operator), the customer also benefits from a large, centralized system's economies of scale.

Operating Personnel. One of the primary advantages to a building owner is that operating personnel for the HVAC system can be reduced or eliminated. Most municipal codes require operating engineers to be on site when high-pressure boilers are in operation. Some older systems require trained operating personnel to be in the boiler/mechanical room at all times. When thermal energy is brought into the building as a utility, depending on the sophistication of the building HVAC controls, there may be opportunity to reduce or eliminate operating personnel.

Insurance. Both property and liability insurance costs are significantly reduced with the elimination of a boiler in the mechanical room, because risk of a fire or accident is reduced.

Usable Space. Usable space in the building increases when a boiler and/or chiller and related equipment are no longer necessary. The noise associated with such in-building equipment is also eliminated. Although this space usually cannot be converted into prime office space, it does provide the opportunity for increased storage or for conversion to other uses.

Equipment Maintenance. With less mechanical equipment, there is proportionately less equipment maintenance, resulting in less expense and a reduced maintenance staff.

Electric Service. The electric service size required is significantly reduced at the site when a chiller is not located on site. This results in lower installation costs for the electric service and a shorter construction schedule. For systems that operate at near-ambient distribution temperatures, this will not be true, and if space and domestic water-heating loads are also being met by exchange with the near-ambient distribution system, electrical service size may need to be increased.

Higher Thermal Efficiency. A larger central plant can achieve higher thermal and emission efficiencies than the sum of several smaller plants. Partial-load performance of central plants may be more efficient than that of many isolated, small systems because the larger plant can operate one or more capacity modules as the combined load requires and can modulate output. Furthermore, central plants take advantage of the fact that buildings that have different functions and their loads do not peak at the same time, but are diversified. With this system diversity, less equipment must be energized to serve the peak system load. Also, central plants generally have efficient base-load units and less costly peaking equipment for use in extreme loads or emergencies. Thornton et al. (2008) found that, although actual operating data on in-building cooling plants are scarce, the limited data available indicate that in-building systems operate at an average efficiency of 0.34 kW/kW of cooling (2.9 COP). Erpelding (2007) found that central district cooling plants can have efficiencies of 0.24 kW/kW (4.1 COP) under less-than-optimal design/operation. Thus, the efficiency of chilled-water generation in a district plant might be estimated to be approximately 40% greater than that of an in-building chiller plant. However, IDEA (2008b) suggested much greater efficiency improvements relative to air-cooled, in-building cooling systems: approximately 0.47 kW/kW (2.1 COP) for air-cooled, in-building systems versus approximately 0.20 kW/kW (5.0 COP) for electrically driven district cooling with thermal storage, an efficiency increase of nearly 140% for district cooling. When strict regulations must be met, additional pollution control equipment is also more economical for larger plants than smaller plants. Cogeneration of heat and electric power results in much higher overall efficiencies than are possible from separate heat and power plants. It is important to note that these comparisons to district cooling relate to central chilled-water generation in the building and in-building distribution by VAV or similar air-based systems.

Lower Utility Rates. Buildings that connect to district energy systems, specifically for cooling, have flatter electrical load profiles once the chilled-water generation equipment is removed from the metered equipment. Flatter electrical profiles are usually conducive to lower electrical rates, because the peaks are removed. Also, the fact that the building has no cooling towers drastically reduces the water and sewer utility bills (i.e., no makeup water and blowdown requirements). Similar benefits exist for gas usage or steam blowdown and makeup needs.

Reliability. DE systems are typically highly reliable and rarely have outages. Mature systems typically have reliability values greater than 99.98%.

Higher Level of Control and Monitoring. Typically, the level and quality of control and monitoring systems in DE systems are superior to commercial-grade HVAC systems in the customer's building, because the consumer's energy is tracked and invoices are prepared using the metered data.

Producer Economics

Available Fuels. Smaller heating plants are usually designed for one type of fuel, which is generally gas or oil. Larger facilities can often be designed for more than one fuel (e.g., gas, biofuels, biomass, coal, oil), and may be combined with power generation (see Chapter 7 for information on combined heat and power systems) for improved system efficiency. Often, larger central DHC plants can operate on less expensive fuels such as coal or municipal refuse.

Energy Source Economics. If an existing facility is the energy source, the available temperature and pressure of the thermal fluid is predetermined. If exhaust steam from an existing electrical generating turbine is used to provide thermal energy, the conditions of the bypass determine the maximum operating pressure and temperature of the DHC system. A trade-off analysis must be conducted to determine what percentage of the energy will be diverted for thermal generation and what percentage will be used for electrical generation. Based on the marginal value of energy, it is critical to determine the operating conditions in the economic analysis.

If a new central plant is being considered, a decision of whether to cogenerate electrical and thermal energy or to generate thermal energy only must be made. An example of cogeneration is a diesel or natural gas engine-driven generator with heat recovery equipment. The engine drives a generator to produce electricity, and heat is recovered from the exhaust, cooling, and lubrication systems. Recovered heat is used for steam or hot-water heating or even as a heat source for a steam-driven turbine or hot-water absorption chiller. Other systems may use one of several available steam turbine designs for cogeneration. These turbine systems combine the thermal and electrical output to obtain the maximum amount of available energy. Chapter 7 has further information on cogeneration.

Temperature and pressure can dramatically affect the economic feasibility of a DHC system design. If the temperature and/or pressure level chosen is too low, a potential customer base might be eliminated. On the other hand, if there is no demand for absorption chillers or high-temperature industrial processes, a low-temperature system usually provides the lowest delivered energy cost.

The availability and location of fuel sources must also be considered in optimizing the economic design of a DHC system. For example, a natural gas boiler might not be feasible where abundant sources of natural gas are not available.

Initial Capital Investment. The initial capital investment for a DHC system is usually the major economic driving force in determining whether there is acceptable payback for implementation. Normally, the initial capital investment includes concept planning and design phases as well as the construction costs of the three major system components: (1) thermal energy production plant, (2) distribution system, and (3) consumer interconnections (also known as energy transfer stations [ETSs]).

Concept Planning. In concept planning phase, many areas are generally reviewed, and the technical feasibility of a DHC system is considered. This includes master planning and estimating system thermal loads and load growth potential, prospective plant site locations, piping routing, and interconnection or conversion requirements in the customer's building. The overall system concept design usually requires the services of an experienced power plant or DHC engineering firm.

Financial Feasibility. The overall capital and operating costs of the DHC system determine the energy rates charged to the prospective customers. These rates must be competitive with the customer's alternative HVAC system life-cycle costs, so a detailed analysis of this system tailored to the nature of the district energy provider is required to determine the system's financial feasibility. For example, a municipal or governmental body must consider availability of bond financing; if the entity is a private/for-profit organization, then the appropriate discount rates must be considered for the financing. Review **alternative energy choices** and **fuel flexibility**, because potential consumers are often asked to sign long-term contracts to justify a DHC system. Fuel flexibility offers the DE provider a method to keep generating costs low by being able to react to spikes in fuel costs. The financial analysis must take into account the equipment's life-cycle costs, including initial construction, operating, maintenance, and replacement, over a system life of at least 50 years.

Final Design. This phase is extremely intensive and may take several years to decades to complete the vision of the district energy provider. All technical assumptions for the design parameters must be confirmed (e.g., temperatures, pressures, flows, loads) while preparing the construction documents for the plant, distribution system, and customer interconnections. The importance of the consumer building's HVAC system water temperatures or steam pressures should not be overlooked, because they essentially drive the selection and sizing of the central plant equipment and distribution materials. Multiple building surveys may be required to determine the piping's exact entry point and routing to the appropriate mechanical or pump room.

System Construction and Costs. The accuracy of construction cost estimates for the central plant, distribution system, and ETS designs depends on the quality and detail of the upfront planning and final design efforts. Although the construction cost usually accounts for most of the initial capital investment, neglect or over/underestimation in any of the other three planning phases could mean the difference between economic success and failure of the DHC system. As with any construction project, field changes usually increase the final cost and delay start-up; therefore, identifying all of the design issues and schedule in advance is extremely important. Even a small delay in start-up can adversely affect both economics and consumer confidence. It is also extremely important that the contractors have experience commensurate with the project difficulty.

Although the plant is a major component of the construction costs, the distribution system also accounts for a significant portion of this initial investment. Distribution design depends on the heat transfer medium chosen, its operating temperature and pressure, and the routing. This system component also has the most risk associated with its installation because it can encounter many underground obstructions. Often, utilities are not well documented in streets, and piping alignment conflicts are not identified until excavation begins. Potholing or exploratory excavations can save project time and costs when used appropriately. Failure to consider these key variables results in higher-than-planned installation costs. An analysis is recommended to determine the distribution system's insulation requirements to determine the required insulating properties and thickness. The section on Economical Thickness for Pipe Insulation discusses determining insulation values.

DHC project costs vary greatly and depend on local construction environment and site conditions such as

- Labor rates
- Construction environment (i.e., slow or busy period)
- Distance to ship equipment
- Permits and fees (e.g., franchise fees)
- Local authorities (e.g., traffic control, times of construction in city streets)
- Soil conditions (e.g., clay, bedrock)
- Quality of equipment and controls (e.g., commercial or industrial)
- Availability of materials
- Size of distribution piping system
- Type of insulation or cathodic protection for buried and aboveground piping system
- Type of distribution system installation (e.g., direct buried, tunnel)
- Distribution system depth of burial and restoration of existing conditions (e.g., city streets, green areas)
- Distribution systems below-grade conflict resolutions
- Economies of scale

Sample construction cost unit pricing is as follows. Typically, the lower unit costs are for larger systems. The designer is cautioned that costs can vary widely because of size, complexity, location, and economic conditions:

- Cooling plant (building, chillers, cooling towers, pumps, piping, controls) = $600 to $1200 per kilowatt
- Boiler plant (building, boilers, stacks, pumps, piping, controls) = $180 to $270 per kilowatt
- Distribution systems (includes excavation, backfill, surface restoration, piping, etc.):
  - Direct-buried chilled-water systems = $1900 to $4900 per metre of trench
  - Direct-buried preinsulated heating piping (steam/condensate and hot water) = $2900 to $5800 per metre of trench
  - Inaccessible tunnels = $2700 to $6000 per metre of trench
  - Walkable tunnels = $14 000 to $58 000 per metre of trench

Lead time needed to obtain equipment generally determines the time required to build a DHC system. In some cases (e.g., large, field-erected chillers; large motors; electrical transformers and switchgear; steam turbines), lead time on major components in the central plant can be over a year.

Installation time of the distribution system depends in part on the routing interference with existing utilities. A distribution system in a new industrial park is simpler and requires less time to install than one in an established business district because of existing utility conflicts and the difficulty of working in active city streets.

Consumer Interconnection or Energy Transfer Stations. These costs are sometimes borne by the consumer either as a first cost or financed and added to their monthly bill. High interconnection costs may favor an in-building plant instead of a DHC system. For example, if an existing building is equipped for steam service, interconnection and conversion to a hot-water DHC system may be cost prohibitive, even though the cost of energy is lower. Similarly high connection costs are encountered if the point of interconnection is in a penthouse mechanical room of a high-rise building.

District Energy Economic Comparison

This section covers economic topics in more detail and helps consultants and building owners compare the costs of self-generated (in-building) central heating and cooling plants to those of a district energy contract or offer. A proper analysis requires more input than just energy and construction costs. The evaluation is extremely site specific and, though not complex, it has many input parameters, some of which are economically quantifiable and others that are qualitative and cannot be assigned a monetary value, although they do affect value.

For quantifiable parameters, the most common method of evaluation is a net present-value or life-cycle cost analysis that encompasses all the major costs and charges associated with each option and includes the time value of money over the life of the project or contract. The following discussion is intended to assist the evaluator in understanding the big picture and identifying all the costs to prepare a fair comparison. Typically, a district energy contract is for a minimum 20-year period and includes all conceivable charges, including some the evaluator may not expect or know. The duration of the contract enables the district energy provider to recoup its costs for expenses incurred in connecting the building or reserving the capacity at the district energy plant for the building's load.

Ideally, a complete economic comparison between self-generated and district energy would include an 8760 h thermal energy load data from an existing building or the results from a computer energy model looking at annual energy usage. An 8760 h analysis is especially preferred for cooling applications using electrically driven equipment, because the reduction in electrical demand charges by connecting to district cooling often results in tremendous savings to the building owner. These savings are best captured by using the exact utility electric rate structure on an annual basis and the information shared with all parties. This is especially true when the building electric rate uses real-time pricing (RTP). Table 1 summarizes the key parameters in a detailed economic comparison calculation.

Because there are benefits to the building owner that cannot be assigned a monetary value, the comparison between the two alternatives should be a value-based decision. In other words, the analysis should not only include quantitative variables, but also qualitative variables and benefits that have intrinsic value to the proposition. For example, some qualitative variables that add value to a building connecting to district energy system could include

- Some of the mechanical and electrical space can be repurposed or rented out for other than storage (e.g., office space, roof garden)
- Reduction in electrical service size to the building, new construction only
- No plumes from cooling towers or boiler stacks
- Increased thermal energy source reliability
- More stable energy costs
- Other than a possible demand charge, a customer is only billed for energy used (metered)
- Fewer greenhouse gas emissions and smaller carbon footprint
- Not having any equipment idling and using energy in hot standby
- Freeing maintenance staff to perform other duties other than central plant operations

Of course, the building owner must determine whether any or all of these parameters pertain or are valuable in a particular building.

See Chapter 38 in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more detailed explanation of preparing a life-cycle cost calculation.

BLCC5.3-18 was used as the financial modeling tool for Example 1. NIST developed the Building Life Cycle Cost (BLCC) programs to provide computational support for analyzing capital investments in buildings. BLCC5, a free download (www.energy.gov/eere/femp/building-life-cycle-cost-programs), combines several considerations into recurring costs: financing, operator salaries, insurance, equipment replacement escrow funds, chemical treatment costs, electricity savings, and annual equipment maintenance costs. Values included in the recurring costs are denoted with an asterisk in Table 3.

Example 1. A building owner is evaluating two different methods of providing chilled water for cooling an office building: purchasing chilled water from a local district cooling provider, or installing a conventional chiller plant. The building load is estimated to be 8440 kW with an annual cooling load of 22 030 500 kWh. The contract is for 25 years, the discount rate is 5.5%, and all costs but water/sewer will be escalated at 3.5%, with water/sewer at 10% per year (based on historical data from municipality).

For alternative 1, the district cooling provider charges are $81.20 capacity charge ($/kW/year applied to peak load) and $0.037 consumption charge ($/kWh) for a total annual energy cost of $1,498,320. Table 2 summarizes the major cost components (obtained from a local contractor) for each alternative. The interconnection charge (heat exchanger, piping, instrumentation, etc.) to the district cooling entity is $289,500. The building owner has decided to pay for this cost by financing it over the life of the contract in lieu of a lump-sum basis.

For alternative 2, the on-site chilled water plant (chillers, pumps, piping and cooling tower, etc.) is estimated to cost $8,981,000, with an expected life of 25 years; 90% of the cost will be financed at 5.5% interest rate. The owner has instructed the engineer to increase the chiller sizes (three at 3165 kW) to accommodate for any future growth, add a little redundancy, and compensate for equipment aging. The cost estimate reflects this. An escrow account for major chiller plant overhaul ($113/kW) was established and is expensed annually. Annual cost for preventative maintenance ($1.70/kW for electrical chillers) was obtained from the local chiller vendor, there is one operator assigned to the plant with an annual salary of $99,000 (includes benefits burden of 40%), and water and sewer charges at $1/m^3 for water and $1/m^3 for blowdown to sewer and chemical treatment ($0.0007/kWh). The cost of insurance per year is based on 0.75% of the total construction costs.

Table 1 Summary of Economic Analysis Factors

Factor	Comments
Capital Costs	
Construction costs of building plant versus energy transfer station equipment	Includes materials and labor for chillers, boilers, piping, pumps, heat exchangers, valving, instrumentation, controls, cost of electric service, cost of additional structures because of equipment weight on roof of building, etc.
Value of increased mechanical and electrical space that would house plant equipment	Includes value of penthouse, basement, roof, and vertical chases for flues, condenser water piping, etc.
Value of any equipment screening	Municipalities often require screening for any equipment mounted on grade or on the roof.
Cost of financing	Amount of project financed at loan interest rate for duration of loan.
Construction permits and fees	Typically a percentage of construction.
Life of major equipment overhauls and replacement costs	Could include replacement or overhauls of chillers, cooling towers, boilers, etc., over life of analysis/contract duration. If district energy contract is for 20 years and a piece of equipment must be replaced or overhauled (e.g., cooling tower replaced after 15 years, chiller/condenser water tube replacement) this cost must be accounted for.
Contract versus installed capacity	District energy capacity will most likely be less than planned in-building installed capacity, as dictated by consultant. Reasons include oversizing and diversity. Typically, estimated peak loads can be reduced to 70%.
Cost of redundant equipment for emergency or standby capacity	Similar to contract versus installed capacity, $N + 1$ redundancy requirements would be accommodated and added to first cost.
Energy and Utility Costs	
Electric rate	From use of each option from energy model or other estimate.
Natural gas rate	From use of each option from energy model or other estimate.
Water and sewer charges for steam, chilled-, and condenser-water systems	From use of each option from energy model or other estimate. Water is increasingly becoming an important resource, so makeup water and equipment blowdown/sewer discharge amount are estimated. It is not uncommon for this utility to have a different escalation rate.
Operations and Maintenance Costs	
Labor and benefits of operations staff assigned to central plant activities	Includes any staff assigned to maintain and operate the central plant, including supervisors, and overtime during unplanned outages.
Replacement or refilling of refrigerants	If refrigerant is scheduled for phasing out, chillers must be retrofitted to accept new refrigerant plus any topping off of refrigerants (or replacement).
Spare parts and supplies	Chiller and boiler and auxiliary equipment require replacement of parts (e.g., gears, oil, tubes) for normal maintenance procedures.
Cost of chemical treatment for steam, chilled, condenser, and hot-water systems	Includes scale and corrosion inhibitors, biocides, oxygen scavengers, etc.; these costs could be considerable.
Cost of contracted maintenance	Some owners outsource specific tasks to service companies such as chiller or boiler maintenance and overhauls.
Energy and Resource Usage	
Peak heating and cooling thermal loads	Used to apply energy demand rate and sizing of plant equipment (chillers, boilers, pumps, electrical service, water service, etc.).
Annual heating and cooling usage	Used to apply utilities' energy consumption rate to equipment meeting thermal loads.
Annual water and sewer usage	Quantify makeup water usage and blowdown discharge pertinent to cooling towers and boilers.
Other Costs	
Architectural and engineering design services	Specifically for new or retrofit applications.
Fees and licenses	Air and water permits, high-pressure steam operator licenses, city franchise fees for running piping in street, etc.
Insurance of equipment	Typically a percentage of construction costs.

Table 2 summarizes the annual utility use for each alternative, and Table 3 estimates annual maintenance and utility costs and commercial tower costs. The chiller plant (chillers, cooling towers, pumps, etc., but not including the distribution pumps) uses 4,389,950 kWh annually at a blended electrical rate of $0.10/kWh. An energy analysis determined that a district energy connection will reduce the electrical demand dramatically with a new blended rate to $0.0875/kWh. If all costs are to be escalated to keep pace with inflation, which option has the lowest life-cycle cost and the lowest net present value?

Solution. Table 4 compares the LCC analysis for the two alternatives. For the values provided, alternative 1 has a 25-year present-value (PV) life-cycle cost of $25,575,051 and the second has a 25-year PV life-cycle cost of $26,171,587. Although these two values are similar and could be considered equal if PV were the only basis for the decision, alternative 1 is preferable because it has the lower life-cycle cost of $596,536 and saves close to $9,000,000 in initial installation costs.

Figure 3 summarizes the major components of the analysis graphically. Note how much the water and sewer costs comprise of the total costs, and that the energy costs only makes up one-third of the life-cycle costs.

2. CENTRAL PLANT

The central plant may include equipment to provide heat only, cooling only, both heat and cooling, or any of these three options in conjunction with electric power generation. In addition to the central plant, small "satellite" plants are sometimes used when a customer's building is in an area where distribution piping is not yet installed.

2.1 HEATING AND COOLING PRODUCTION

Heating Medium

In plants serving hospitals, industrial customers, or cogeneration sites (i.e., those also generating electricity), steam is the usual choice for production in the plant and, often, for distribution to customers. For systems serving largely commercial buildings, hot water is usually an attractive medium. From the standpoint of distribution, hot water can accommodate a greater geographical area than steam because of the ease with which booster pump stations can be installed. The common attributes and relative merits of hot

Table 2 Annual Utility Consumption Summary for Central Plant Alternatives

Utility	Alternative 1	Alternative 2
Electrical, kWh	0	4 389 950
Water, m^3	0	61 252
Sewer, m^3	0	14 282

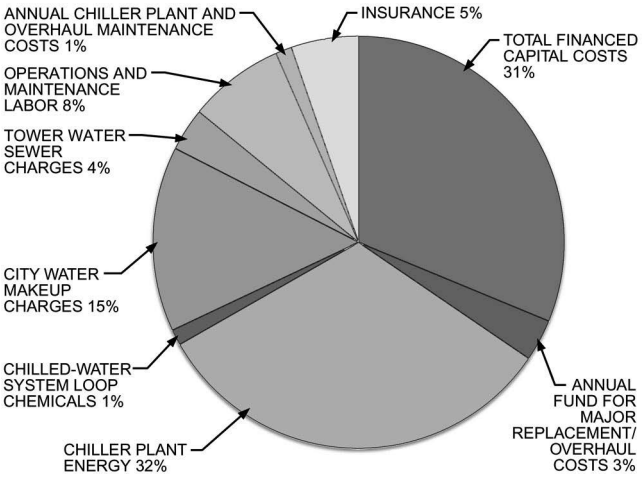


Fig. 3 Breakdown of Life-Cycle Cost by Components for Example 1

water and steam as heat-conveying media are described as follows. More information is also available in Chapter 11 of this volume, and in Chapter 3 of the *District Heating Guide*, 2nd ed. (ASHRAE 2019).

Heat Capacity. Steam relies primarily on the latent heat capacity of water rather than on sensible heat. The net heat content for saturated steam at 690 kPa (gage) (170°C) condensed and cooled to 80°C is approximately 2400 kJ/kg. Hot water cooled from 175 to 120°C has a net heat effect of 240 kJ/kg, or only about 10% as much as that of steam. Thus, a hot-water system must circulate about 10 times more mass than a steam system of similar heat capacity.

Pipe Sizes. Despite the fact that less steam is required for a given heat load, and flow velocities are greater, steam usually requires a larger pipe size for the supply line because of its lower density (Aamot and Phetteplace 1978). This is compensated for by a much smaller condensate return pipe. Therefore, piping costs for steam and condensate are often comparable with those for hot-water supply and return, especially given the fact that trap station vaults are not required.

Return System. Condensate return systems require more maintenance than hot-water return systems because hot-water systems function as a closed loop with very low makeup water requirements. For condensate return systems, corrosion of piping and other components is a problem, particularly where feedwater is high in bicarbonates. Nonmetallic piping is essentially impervious to corrosion, but material temperature limitations mean it should only be used with caution and in carefully selected installations for condensate return. Suitable applications include low-temperature pumped returns, where it is possible to isolate the nonmetallic piping from live steam. Otherwise, avoid using nonmetallic piping in steam systems because its material temperature limits can easily be exceeded by steam trap failures and exposure to high-temperature condensate or live steam.

Similar concerns are associated with condensate drainage systems (steam traps, condensate pumps, and receiver tanks) for steam supply lines. Carefully consider condensate collection and return when designing a steam system. Although similar problems with water treatment occur in hot-water systems, they present less of a concern because makeup rates are much lower.

Table 3 Estimates of Annual Maintenance and Utility Costs and Commercial Tower Costs

Cost Category	Alternative 1	Alternative 2
Annual Maintenance and Utilities		
Chiller operation and maintenance*	$0	$ 32,460
Chiller replacement escrow*	$0	$ 43,200
Operator salaries*	$0	$ 99,000
Estimated water and sewer*	$0	$ 78,816
Estimated chemicals*	$0	$ 15,660
Insurance*	$0	$ 67,358
Total	**$0**	**$336,494**
Electric Utility Cost	$(182,316)	$438,995
Probable Costs for Commercial Tower		
Electrical equipment	18,000	$520,000
Chilled water side equipment and piping	$140,000	$1,650,000
Condenser water side equipment and piping	$0	$2,075,000
Plumbing (floor drains, makeup water piping, etc.)	$5,000	$131,000
Miscellaneous mechanical (HVAC, lighting, equipment rooms)	$5,000	$120,000
General construction (walls, floors, equip pads, cooling tower support, etc.)	$15,000	$1,146,000
Controls (building management system, instrumentation, start-up, commissioning)	$8,000	$325,000
Total Construction Costs	**$191,000**	**$5,967,000**
Contractor's fee (7%)	$13,000	$420,000
Construction contingency (10%)	$19,000	$595,000
Subtotal	**$223,000**	**$6,965,000**
Contractor's general conditions (10%)	$22,300	$696,500
Subtotal	**$245,300**	**$7,662,000**
Sales tax (5.6%)	$14,000	$429,000
Subtotal	**$259,300**	**$8,091,000**
Consultant design fees (9.0%)	$25,000	$728,000
Permits and fees (2%)	$5,000	$162,000
TOTAL	**$289,500**	**$8,981,000**

*Included in recurring costs category.

Pressure and Temperature Requirements. Flowing steam and hot water both incur pressure losses. Hot-water systems may use intermediate booster pumps to increase the pressure at points between the plant and the consumer. Because of the higher density of water, pressure variations caused by elevation differences in a hot-water system are much greater than for steam systems. This can adversely affect the economics of a hot-water system by requiring use of a higher pressure class of piping and/or booster pumps or even heat exchangers used as pressure interceptors.

Regardless of the medium used, the temperature and pressure used for heating should be no higher than needed to satisfy consumer requirements; this cannot be overemphasized. Higher temperatures and pressures require additional engineering and planning to avoid higher heat losses and higher piping stress forces. Safety and comfort levels for operators and maintenance personnel also benefit from lower temperature and pressure. Higher temperatures may require higher pressure ratings for piping and fittings and may preclude the use of less expensive materials such as polyurethane foam insulation and nonmetallic conduits.

In North America, hot-water systems are divided into three temperature classes:

- High-temperature hot-water (HTHW) systems supply temperatures over 175°C.

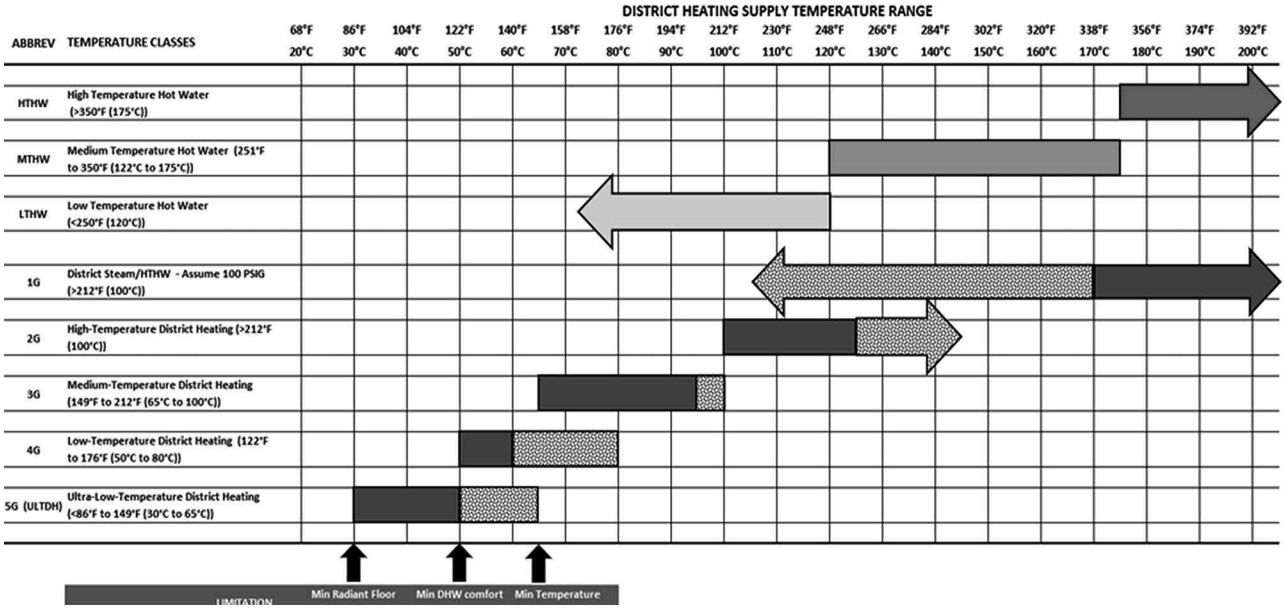


Fig. 4 District Energy Temperature Ranges and Use of DH Generational Definitions

(Assembled by Steve Tredennick from multiple sources, including Lund 2021)

- Medium-temperature hot-water (MTHW) systems supply temperatures in the range of 120 to 175°C.
- Low-temperature hot-water (LTHW) systems supply temperatures of 120°C or lower.

The global district energy industry is evolving to lower supply and operating temperatures to use additional low-grade heat and waste heat sources as a tool for decarbonization. As such, there has been a movement in Europe to define the district energy systems from a more historical/generational viewpoint by their temperature range.

Furthermore, the Swedish district heating industry (Werner 2013) has some further definitions classifying the generation of systems based on the time period, heating media and temperatures used:

- 1st Generation (1G) – Steam based systems (1880 to 1930).
- 2nd Generation (2G) – Pressurized superheated water (1930 to 1980)
- 3rd Generation (3G) – Pressurized water (1980 to 2020)
- 4th (4G) and 5th Generation (5G) – Pressurized water (2020 to present)

Per Lund (2021), the system definitions start at the first-generation district heating, or 1GDH, which was for steam systems, to 5GDHC (fifth-generation district heating and cooling). 5GDHC systems have also been described as **ambient loops** for use in community heat pump systems, or **ultra-low-temperature district heating (ULTDH)**. With each generation, the operating temperatures are lowered. Although there appears to be no standardized or codified values for 4G and 5G systems or the use of low- and ultra-low-temperature district heating system definitions, Figure 4 attempts to summarize the current industry understanding. It is important to note that 4G and 5G systems will need some other method of heating to generate domestic hot water above 60°C.

The temperature drop at the consumer end should be as high as possible, preferably 22 K or greater. A large temperature drop allows the fluid flow rate through the system, pumping power, return temperatures, return line heat loss, and condensing temperatures in cogeneration power plants to be reduced. A large customer temperature drop can often be achieved by cascading loads operating at different temperatures. Typical Scandinavian LTHW systems have temperature drops of 40 K or greater. Chapter 15 provides more information on medium- and high-temperature water-heating systems.

In many instances, existing equipment and processes require the use of steam, which precludes use of hot water or requires smaller high-pressure boilers at the buildings. See the section on Consumer Interconnections for further information.

Steam and Hot Water Generation

With few exceptions, boilers are constructed to meet requirements in the sections on constructing heating and power boilers of the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* (2013). Low-pressure boilers are constructed for maximum working pressures of 103.4 kPa (gage) steam and up to 1103 kPa (gage) hot water. Low-pressure hot-water boilers are limited to 121.1°C operating temperature. High-pressure boilers are designed to operate above 103.4 kPa steam or above 1103 kPa (gage) and/or 121.1°C for water boilers.

In the United States, boilers are rated by boiler horsepower, with 1 hp being equal to 9.81 kW or the evaporation of 15.65 kg of water per hour at standard atmospheric pressure 101.4 kPa and 100°C. Every steam or water boiler is rated for a maximum working pressure according to its applicable boiler code. When installed, it also must be equipped at a minimum with operation and safety controls and pressure-/temperature-relief devices mandated by such codes.

Fire-tube and water-tube boilers are available for gas/oil firing (see Chapter 32 for details). If coal is used, either package-type coal-fired boilers in small sizes (less than 2.5 to 3 kg/s) or field-erected boilers in larger sizes are available. Coal-firing underfeed stokers are available up to a 4 to 4.5 kg/s capacity; traveling grate and spreader stokers are available up to 20 kg/s capacity in single-boiler installations. Fluidized-bed boilers can be installed for capacities over 40 kg/s. Larger coal-fired boilers are typically multiple installations of the three types of stokers or larger, pulverized fired or fluidized-bed boilers. Generally, the complexity of fluidized bed or pulverized firing does not lend itself to small central heating plant operation. Coal-fired boilers typically can be partially cofired with other solid fuels such as wood biomass, refuse, or tire-derived fuels (TDF), or retrofitted to combust a higher percentage of nonfossil fuels.

Table 4 LLC Example of District Cooling Evaluation

Alternative 1: Purchase Chilled Water from District Cooling Provider

	Year										
	0	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**
Recurring costs	$0	($37,298)	($39,352)	($41,381)	($43,583)	($45,869)	($48,228)	($50,670)	($53,197)	($55,820)	($58,527)
Chilled-water cost	$0	$1,586,876	$1,634,449	$1,683,448	$1,733,917	$1,786,043	$1,839,587	$1,894,736	$1,951,539	$2,010,207	$2,070,471
Net annual cash flow	$0	$1,586,876	$1,634,449	$1,683,448	$1,733,917	$1,786,043	$1,839,587	$1,894,736	$1,951,539	$2,010,207	$2,070,471

	11	**12**	**13**	**14**	**15**	**…**	**23**	**24**	**25**
Recurring costs	($61,329)	($64,228)	($67,238)	($70,345)	($73,560)	—	($99,468)	($103,702)	($108,071)
Chilled-water cost	$2,132,542	$2,196,474	$2,262,506	$2,330,334	$2,400,195	—	$2,951,997	$3,040,495	$3,131,393
Net annual cash flow	$2,132,542	$2,196,474	$2,262,506	$2,330,334	$2,400,195	—	$2,951,997	$3,040,495	$3,131,393

25-year Net Present Value $25,575,051; Sum of 25-year Cash Flows = $52,991,400

Alternative 2: Design and Install On-Site 8440 kW Chilled-Water System

	Year										
	0	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**
Initial cost	$898,100	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Recurring cost	$0	$923,570	$934,797	$946,416	$958,442	$970,924	$983,807	$997,141	$1,010,941	$1,025,264	$1,040,047
Energy cost	$0	$517,264	$535,356	$554,080	$573,459	$593,572	$614,333	$635,820	$658,058	$681,138	$704,961
Water cost	$0	$1,535,306	$1,573,015	$1,612,550	$1,654,028	$1,697,695	$1,743,444	$1,791,539	$1,842,133	$1,895,547	$184,634
Sewer cost	$0	$923,570	$934,797	$946,416	$958,442	$970,924	$983,807	$997,141	$1,010,941	$1,025,264	$22,029
Net annual cash flow	$0	$517,264	$535,356	$554,080	$573,459	$593,572	$614,333	$635,820	$658,058	$681,138	$184,634

	11	**12**	**13**	**14**	**15**	**…**	**23**	**24**	**25**
Initial cost	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Recurring cost	$1,055,348	$1,071,184	$1,087,620	$1,104,585	$1,122,143	—	$1,263,626	$1,286,746	$1,310,609
Energy cost	$729,618	$755,137	$781,622	$808,959	$837,253	—	$1,065,245	$1,102,502	$1,140,956
Water cost	$203,084	$223,377	$245,763	$270,322	$297,335	—	$579,459	$637,364	$700,871
Sewer cost	$22,800	$23,597	$24,425	$25,279	$26,163	—	$33,288	$34,452	$35,654
Net annual cash flow	$203,084	$223,377	$245,763	$270,322	$297,335	—	$579,459	$637,364	$700,871

25-year Net Present Value $26,171,587; Sum of 25-year Cash Flows = $53,616,410

Chilled-Water Generation

As with smaller in-building chilled-water plants, district plants have options for which chiller type, refrigerant, and prime drivers to use. Chiller types in district cooling systems vary by location, depending on parameters such as water availability, power availability, maximum power demand that can be offered by the utility, steam availability, gas or fuel oil availability, distribution temperature required, plant location with respect to development, and applied environment impact regulations (including pollution and noise control).

The chillers may be classified according to

- Refrigerant and compressor technology (centrifugal, screw, absorption, etc.)
- Heat rejection source (air cooled or water cooled)
- Driving energy source (electric motor, steam turbine, hot water or steam absorption, internal combustion engine, etc.)
- Supply temperature required
- Size: capacity in kilowatts

Chiller condenser heat rejection can be air cooled or water cooled. **Air-cooled chillers** are typically packaged, with controls, compressors, evaporator, and air-cooled condenser all on the same skid. Their capacity may be as high as 1600 kW, and they have been implemented in several central plants by installing multiple units in chiller farms, either on grade or on building rooftops.

Water-cooled chillers reject heat carried by the water circuit through either bodies of water (rivers, lakes, and oceans), cooling towers (evaporative cooling), or radiators. The limiting factor of the capacity of a cooling tower is the ambient wet-bulb temperature. Because the wet-bulb temperature is lower than the coincident dry-bulb temperature, a cooling tower with a water-cooled chiller is more efficient than an air-cooled one at removing chiller heat because of the lower condensing temperature: more energy can be rejected by evaporating one kilogram of water than by raising the temperature of an equivalent amount of air. Because water-cooled chiller plants are typically considerably more efficient than either air-cooled or water-cooled radiator plants, they require less heat rejection area. Tables 5 and 6 summarize the available chiller technologies, efficiencies with first cost and maintenance costs.

The chilled-water supply temperature for a conventional system ranges from 5 to 7°C. Chilled-water return temperatures are set as high as practical to increase the temperature difference Δt between supply and return, reducing the quantity of chilled water circulated in the system. Note that ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 requires new cooling coils to be selected for at least a 8 K Δt between the leaving and entering water temperatures, and the leaving water temperature

Table 5 Chiller Technology

	Compression Chillers			Absorption Chillers	
Parameter	Reciprocating	Screw	Centrifugal	One-stage	Two-stage
Primary energy	Electric motor	Electric motor	Electric motor	Hot water, 65 to 80°C	Steam or fire, temperature > 170°C
Fluids	R-134a, HCFC, NH_3	R-134a, HCFC, NH_3	R-134a, HCFC, NH_3	H_2O with LiBr, NH_3 with H_2O	H_2O with LiBr, NH_3 with H_2O
COP	4 to 6	4 to 6	>7.0	0.6 to 0.75	1.2

Table 6 Summary Table of Chiller Characteristics

Chiller Type	Typical Efficiency	Size Range, kW	Equipment Cost, $/kW	Estimated Annual Maintenance Costs*
Electric centrifugal (standard single compressor)	2.15 to 2.46 kW/kW (COP 4.7 to 5.4)	1760 to >5275	74 to 101	$4810
Electric centrifugal (standard dual compressor)	2.15 to 2.46 kW/kW (COP 4.7 to 5.4)	5275 to 14 000	93 to 130 148 to 166	$5720 to $6500 $4810 to $5460
Electric centrifugal (single compressor industrial, field erected)	2.15 to 2.46 kW/kW (COP 4.7 to 5.4)	8790 to >19 340	240 to 358	$6240 to $7150
Engine-driven centrifugal	(COP 1.5 to 1.9)	350 to >10 550	166 to 240	$5720 + engine maintenance
Steam-driven centrifugal	—	350 to 14 000	—	$4550+ depending on size
Direct-fired (double effect) absorption chiller	(COP 0.85 to 1.20)	<350 to >11 430	148 to 740	$6240 to $7150
Hot-water absorption chiller (single effect)	(COP 0.55 to 0.70)	<210 to >11 430	166 to 369	$6240 to $7150
Steam absorption chiller (single effect)	(COP 0.60 to 0.75)	<210 to >11 430	188 to 295	$6240 to $7150

*Maintenance costs courtesy of Johnson Controls, Inc./York International. Typical annual activities include changing oil filter, oil filter analysis and motor checks. Costs do not include cleaning tubes, eddy current testing, or complete oil or refrigerant replacement. Approximate pricing for those additional items follows:

- Cleaning evaporator or condenser tubes as required, use $1560.
- Eddy current testing for under 1760 kW chiller, use $2210; for larger chillers, $3250.
- Complete oil replacement: contact vendor's service department.

For all absorbers, a bromide test is conducted twice per year. Costs do not include chemicals.

must not be lower than 13.9°C. This dictates at least at 5.6°C coil entering chilled-water temperature. Until the requirement was added in 2016, traditional cooling systems used a 7 K Δt, resulting in a flow rate of 2.4 L/min per kilowatt (40 g/kJ) of chilled water. Furthermore, when selecting a chilled-water supply temperature, pump heat gains and distribution heat losses must be accounted for, as well. Distribution heat gains/losses are covered in more detail later in this chapter. Pump heat gain is a function of pump pressure and at design conditions is

$$\text{Pump Heat Gain} = \Delta t = H(1 - \mu)/(102 c_p \mu)$$

where

Δt = temperature rise, K
H = total pressure, m
μ = pump efficiency, in decimal (%)
c_p = specific heat of liquid in pump, kJ/(kg·K)

Example 2. Calculate the temperature rise of a pump flowing 4.4°C water with the following characteristics: 45.72 m of head, and 75% pump efficiency. Water at 4.4°C has a specific heat of 4.204 kJ/(kg·K).

Solution:

$$\Delta t = 45.72(1 - 0.75)/(102 \times 4.204 \times 0.75) = 0.036 \text{ K}$$

Because of the cost of the distribution system piping and pumping energy, modern chilled-water systems should strive to operate at lower supply water temperatures and/or higher return water temperatures to allow a larger Δt to be achieved, thereby reducing chilled-water flow per kilowatt of capacity. For systems involving stratified chilled-water storage, a practical lower limit is 4°C because of water density considerations; however, chemical additives can suppress this temperature below –2°C. For ice storage systems, supply water temperatures as low as 1°C have been used.

Multiple air-conditioning loads connected to a central chilled-water system provide economic advantages and energy conservation opportunities over a decentralized system approach. In addition, central plants afford the opportunity to use refrigerants such as ammonia that may be impractical for use in individual buildings. The size of air-conditioning loads served, diversity among the loads, and their distance from the chilling plant are principal factors in determining the feasibility of large central plants. The distribution system pipe capacity is directly proportional to the operating temperature difference between the supply and return lines, and it benefits additionally from increased diversity in the connected loads.

For extremely large district systems, several plants may be required to meet the loads economically and provide redundancy. In some areas, plants over 70 000 kW are common for systems exceeding a total connected load of 175 000 kW. Another reason for multiple plants is that single plants over 100 000 kW can require large piping headers (over 1200 mm in diameter) in the plant, as well as large distribution headers in streets already congested with other utilities, making piping layout problematic. Multiple plants use smaller distribution piping and thus increase system constructability, redundancy, and reliability.

An economic evaluation of piping and pumping costs versus chiller power requirements can establish the most suitable supply and return water temperatures. When sizing piping and calculating pumping cost, the heat load on the chiller generated by the frictional heating of the flowing fluid should be considered because most of the pumping power adds to the system heat load. For high chiller efficiency, it is often more efficient to use isolated auxiliary equipment for special process requirements and to allow the central plant supply water temperature to float up at times of lower load. As with heating plants, optimum chilled-water control may require a combination of temperature modulation and flow modulation. However, the designer must investigate the effects of higher chilled-water supply temperatures on chilled-water secondary system distribution flows and air-side system performance (humidity control) before applying this to individual central water plants.

Thermal Storage

Both hot- and chilled-water thermal storage can be implemented for district systems. In North America, the current economic situ-

ation primarily results in chilled-water storage applications. Depending on plant design and loading, thermal storage can reduce chiller equipment requirements and lower operating costs. By shifting part of the chilling load, chillers can be sized closer to the average load than the peak load. Shifting some or all of the refrigeration load to off peak reduces the on-peak electrical demand load while using the same (or slightly larger) chiller machine capacity. Because many utilities offer lower rates (and perhaps some rebates) during off-peak periods, operating costs for electrically driven chillers can be substantially reduced.

Both ice and chilled-water storage have been applied to district-sized chiller plants. In general, the largest systems (>250 GJ capacity) use chilled-water (CHW) storage and small- to moderate-sized systems use ice storage. Storage capacities in the 120 to 400 GJ range are now common and systems have been installed up to 1600 GJ for district cooling systems. When CHW storage is feasible, be careful not to reduce the chilled-water temperature below 4°C, to allow proper temperature stratification in the thermal energy storage (TES) tank. A TES tank charging temperature lower than 3.9°C without low-temperature additives will result in mixing in the tank, loss of tank stratification, and possibly disturbance of the system supply temperature and the storage concept.

For these reasons, most chilled-water plants are designed for a 4.4°C supply temperature and a 13.3°C or greater return temperature. Some plants may be designed for lower temperatures by using multiple cascaded heat exchangers in series, such as high-rise towers; however, note that each 0.6 K reduction in supply temperature increases chiller-specific energy consumption (i.e., kW/kW) by approximately 2%. Some plants are designed for a higher return temperature (15.5°C or higher) to increase the Δt, but this requires a great deal of additional coordination with the design of the building's HVAC system to ensure the system operates per design intent.

In Europe, several cooling systems use naturally occurring underground aquifers (caverns) for storage of chilled water. Selection of the storage configuration (chilled-water steel tank above grade, chilled-water concrete tank below grade, ice direct, ice indirect) is often influenced by space limitations. Depending on the system design temperatures, chilled-water storage requires four to six times the volume of ice storage for the same capacity. For chilled-water storage, the footprint of steel tanks (depending on height) can be less than concrete tanks for the same volume (Andrepont 1995); furthermore, the cost of above-grade tanks is usually less than below-grade tanks.

Chapter 51 has additional information on thermal storage; for thermal storage specifically in district cooling and heating, also see Phetteplace et al. (2013, 2019), respectively.

Auxiliaries

Numerous pieces of auxiliary support equipment related to the boiler and chiller operations are not unique to the production plant of a DHC system and are found in similar installations. Some components of a DHC system deserve special consideration because of their critical nature and potential effect on operations.

Although instrumentation can be either electronic or pneumatic, electronic instrumentation systems offer the flexibility of combining control systems with data acquisition systems. This combination brings improved efficiency, better energy management, and reduced operating staff for the central heating and/or cooling plant. For systems involving multiple fuels and/or thermal storage, computer-based controls are indispensable for accurate decisions about boiler and chiller operation.

Boiler feedwater treatment has a direct bearing on equipment life. Condensate receivers, filters, polishers, and chemical feed equipment must be accessible for proper management, maintenance, and operation. Depending on the temperature, pressure, and quality of the heating medium, water treatment may require softeners, alkalizers, and/or demineralizers for systems operating at high temperatures and pressures.

Equipment and layout of a central heating and cooling plant should reflect what is required for proper plant operation and maintenance. The plant should have an adequate service area for equipment and a sufficient number of electrical power outlets and floor drains. Equipment should be placed on housekeeping pads to protect the bases from spills or leaks. Figure 5 presents a typical layout for a large hot-water/chilled-water plant. Notice that the layout provides space for future expansion as well as storage of spare parts. The control room is typically close to the operating equipment for ease of visual inspection. Other functions that should be considered include adequate space for maintenance, chemical treatment laboratory and chemical storage, and operator conveniences such as locker rooms and lunch rooms. Designers must follow the requirements of ASHRAE *Standard* 15 for ventilation as well as laying out the equipment room, and should coordinate with the architect regarding tight-sealing doors, minimizing penetrations, etc.

Expansion Tanks and Water Makeup. The expansion tank is usually located in the central plant building. To control pressure, either air or nitrogen is introduced to the air space in the expansion tank. To function properly, the expansion tank must be the single point of the system where no pressure change occurs. Multiple, air-filled tanks may cause erratic and possibly harmful movement of air though the piping and should be avoided. Although diaphragm expansion tanks eliminate air movement, the possibility of hydraulic surge should be considered. On large chilled-water systems, a makeup water pump generally is used to makeup water loss. The pump is typically controlled from level switches on the expansion tank or from a desired pump suction pressure.

A conventional water meter on the makeup line can show water loss in a closed system. This meter also provides necessary data for water treatment. The fill valve should be controlled to open or close and not modulate to a very low flow, so that the water meter can detect all makeup. For systems with thermal energy storage (TES) tanks, consider providing a rapid-fill connection from either the domestic water system or an adjacent fire hydrant connection. Use caution if connecting to the fire line, because this water would be untreated and raw, and would require chemical treatment; hence, the chemical treatment system should also be sized for a rapid-fill event.

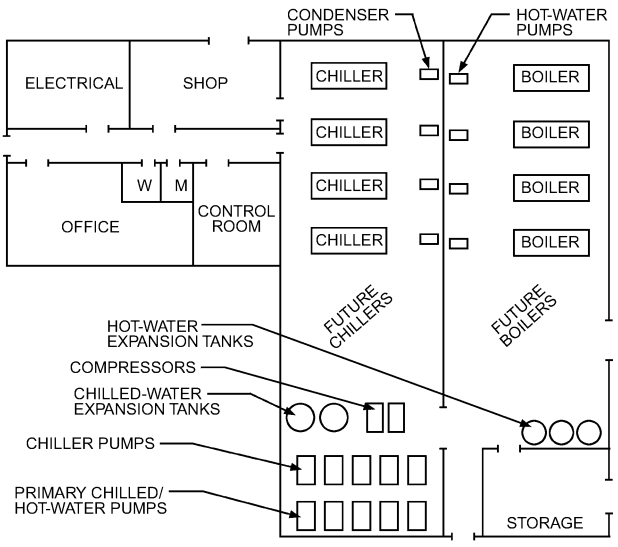


Fig. 5 Layout for Hot-Water/Chilled-Water Plant

Air Venting. Air in water systems can cause major issues for district systems, because it acts as insulator for heat transfer and increases corrosion in system components (e.g., chillers, pipes, heat exchangers). Trapped air causes air pockets in the CHW system that can accumulate at fittings and prohibit flow, causing the system to become **air bound**. Sources of air in a closed system include

- Makeup water containing normal amounts of dissolved air
- Air trapped in the system after initial filling
- Diffusion
- Air ingress caused by negative pressure

Several devices are used to eliminate air from CHW systems. Air exists within the system in three forms: (1) stagnant bubbles, (2) entrained in the flow, and (3) dissolved. Large, stagnant bubbles can be removed by manual or automatic venting if enough pressure is available. If bubble size exceeds the air vent passage, a capillary problem occurs and prevents bubble removal. In this case, use either a surface tension breaker or a large-bore vent (13 mm). Centrifugal separators are ideally suited for continuous gas venting in district plants.

For proper separator function, velocity through the separator should not exceed 0.03 m/s and should allow for water turbulence. Some separators contain a zone to collect dirt and blow it down. Dissolved air (invisible) is difficult to remove through separators or air vents, but can be removed using a vacuum-pressure degasser, in which a fraction of the circulated water is put into a vacuum, allowing separation and removal of dissolved gas.

Emission Control. In all cases, the cleanest fuel should be used to minimize emissions and environmental impacts. Emission treatment equipment, including electrostatic precipitators, baghouses, and scrubbers, is required to meet emission standards for coal-fired or solid-waste-fired operations. Proper control is critical to equipment operation, and it should be designed and located for easy access by maintenance personnel.

A baghouse gas filter provides good service if gas flow and temperature are properly maintained. Because baghouses are designed for continuous online use, they are less suited for cyclic operation. Cyclical heating and cooling of the fabric significantly reduces the useful life of the bags through acidic condensation. Using an economizer to preheat boiler feedwater and help control flue gas temperature may enhance baghouse operation. Contaminants generated by plant operation and maintenance, such as washdown of floors and equipment, may need to be contained.

Local codes and regulations may also require low-NO_x burners on gas- or oil-fired boilers or engine generators. Chapter 28 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* and Chapter 30 of this volume have information on air pollution and its control.

2.2 CHILLED-WATER DISTRIBUTION DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

Water distribution systems are designed for either constant flow (variable return temperature) or variable flow (constant return temperature). The design decision between constant- or variable-volume flow affects the (1) selection and arrangement of the chiller(s), (2) design of the distribution system, and (3) design of the customer connection to the distribution system. Unless very unusual circumstances exist, most systems large enough to be considered in the district category are likely to benefit from variable-flow design. See Chapter 13 for additional information on pumping.

Constant Flow

In the past, constant chilled-water flow was applied only to smaller systems where simplicity of design and operation were important and where distribution pumping costs were low, before variable- and adjustable-speed drives were available and affordable. (However, for new systems, designers should refer to ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1, which requires variable-flow pumping.) Chillers were also arranged in series to handle higher system design temperature differentials. Flow rate through a full-load distribution system depended on the type of constant-flow system used. A common technique connected the building and its terminal units across the distribution system. The central plant pump circulated chilled water through air-side terminal units controlled by three-way valves (constant-volume direct primary pumping). Balancing problems could occur in this design when many separate flow circuits were interconnected (Figure 6).

Constant-flow distribution was also applied to in-building (secondary or tertiary) circuits with separate pumps. This arrangement isolates the flow balance problem between buildings. In this case, flow through the distribution system could be significantly lower than the sum of the flows needed by the terminal if the in-building system supply temperature were higher than the distribution system supply temperature (Figure 5). The water temperature rise in the distribution system was determined by the connected in-building systems and their controls.

In constant-flow design, chillers arranged in parallel have decreased entering water temperatures at part load; thus, several machines might have needed to run simultaneously, each at a reduced load, to produce the required chilled-water flow. In this case, chillers in series were better because constant flow could be maintained though the chilled-water plant at all times, with only the chillers required for producing chilled water energized. Legacy constant-flow systems should be analyzed thoroughly when considering multiple chillers in a parallel arrangement, because the auxiliary electric loads of condenser water pumps, tower fans, and central plant circulating pumps are a significant part of the total energy input. Contemporary control systems mitigate the reason for constant flow through the chillers, and variable flow should be used for larger systems.

Variable Flow

Variable-flow design can significantly reduce energy use and expand the capacity of the distribution system piping by using

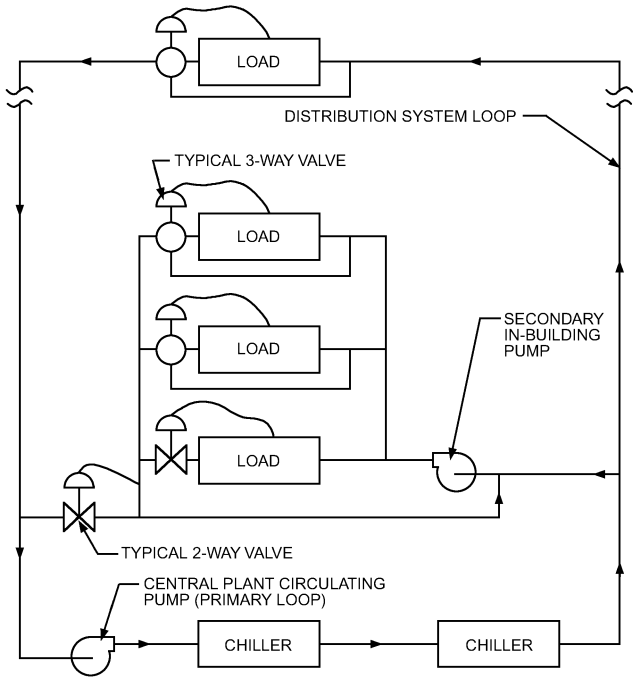


Fig. 6 Constant-Flow Primary Distribution with Secondary Pumping with Series Chillers

diversity. To maintain a high temperature differential at part load, the distribution system flow rate must track the load imposed on the central plant. Multiple parallel pumps or, more commonly, variable-speed pumps can reduce flow and pressure, and lower pumping energy at part load. Terminal device controls should be selected to ensure that variable flow objectives are met. Correctly sized terminal unit flow-throttling (two-way) valves, and especially pressure-independent control valves (PICV), provide the continuous high return temperature needed to correlate the system load change to a system flow change.

Systems in each building are usually two-pipe, with individual in-building pumping. In some cases, the pressure of the distribution system may cause flow through the in-building system without in-building pumping. Distribution system pumps can provide total building system pumping if (1) the distribution system pressure drops are minimal, and (2) the distribution system is relatively short-coupled (1000 m or less). To implement this pumping method, the total flow must be pumped at a pressure sufficient to meet the requirements of the building with the largest pressure differential requirement. Consequently, all buildings on the system should have their pressure differentials monitored and transmitted to the central plant, where pump speeds are adjusted to provide adequate pressure to the building with the lowest margin of pressure differential (i.e., hydraulically most remote or the critical node).

If the designer has control over the design of each in-building system, this pumping method can be achieved in a reasonable manner. In retrofits where existing buildings under different ownership are connected to a new central plant, coordination is difficult and individual building pumps are more practical.

When buildings have separate circulating pumps, use hydraulic isolating piping and pumping design to ensure that two-way control valves are subjected only to the differential pressure established by the in-building pump. Figure 7 shows a connection using in-building pumping with hydraulic isolation from the primary loop.

When in-building pumps are used, all series interconnections between the distribution system pump and the in-building pumps should be removed. Without adequate instrumentation and controls, a series connection can cause the distribution system return to operate at a higher pressure than the distribution system supply and disrupt flow to adjacent buildings. Series operation often occurs during improper use of three-way mixing valves in the distribution-to-building connection.

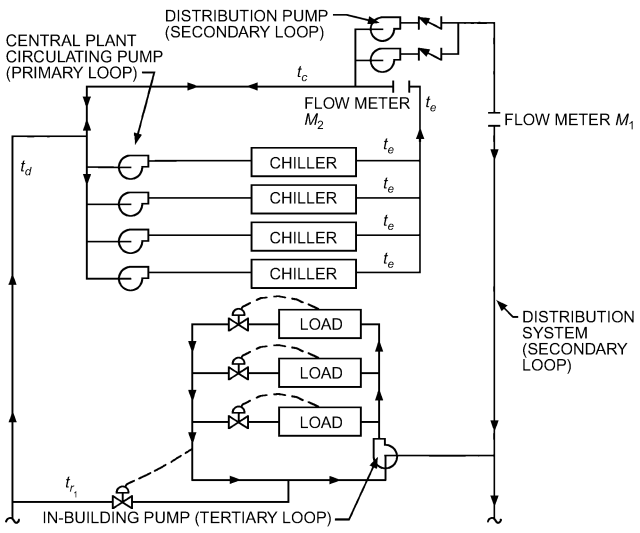


Fig. 7 Variable-Flow Primary/Secondary Systems with Parallel Chillers

In very large systems, **distributed pumping** may be used. Under this approach, the distribution pumps in the central plant are eliminated and relocated to the buildings, so all the electrical energy is borne by the pumps in the user buildings. Where the distribution network piping constitutes a significant pressure loss (systems covering a large area), this design allows the distributed pumps in the buildings to be sized for just the pressure loss imposed at that particular location. Ottmer and Rishel (1993) found that this approach reduces total chilled-water pump power by 20 to 25% in very large systems. It is best applied in new construction where the central plant and distributed building systems can be planned fully and coordinated initially. Note that this system is not the best approach for a system that expects dynamic growth, such as a college and university campus, because adding a large load anywhere in the system adversely affects the pressure drop of each distribution pump. Furthermore, it is a common design approach to oversize distribution piping in distributed pumping systems to keep the distribution pressure drop low, to reduce the pressure drop and size of the building distribution pumps.

Usually, a positive pressure must be maintained at the highest point of the system at all times. This height determines the static pressure at which the expansion tank operates. Excessively tall buildings that do not isolate the in-building systems from the distribution system can impose unacceptable static pressure on the distribution system. To prevent excessive operating pressure in distribution systems, heat exchangers have been used to isolate the in-building system from the distribution system to act as pressure interceptors. To ensure reasonable temperature differentials between supply and return temperatures, flow must be controlled on the distribution system side of the heat exchanger.

In high-rise buildings, all piping, valves, coils, and other equipment may be required to withstand high pressure. Where system static pressure exceeds safe or economical operating pressure, either the heat exchanger method or pressure-sustaining valves in the return line with check valves in the supply line may be used to minimize pressure. However, the pressure-sustaining/check valve arrangement may overpressurize the entire distribution system if a malfunction of either valve occurs.

Chilled-Water System Design Guidelines

Guidelines for plant design and operation include the following:

- Variable-speed pumping saves energy and should be considered for distribution system pumping.
- Design chilled-water systems to optimize the temperature differential of at least 8 K with an upper temperature differential limit of 9 to 13 K. Investigate using chillers arranged in series for larger temperature differentials or increased chiller efficiency.
- Larger central chilled-water plants with high distribution system pressure drops can benefit from variable flow in the distribution system. This can be achieved with variable primary, primary/secondary, or primary/secondary/tertiary pumping systems.
- Size the distribution system for a low overall total pressure loss. Short-coupled distribution systems (1000 m or less) can be used for a total pressure loss of 60 to 120 kPa. With this maximum differential between any points in the system, size the distribution pumps to provide the necessary pressure to circulate chilled water through the in-building systems, eliminating the need for in-building pumping systems. This decreases the complexity of operating central chilled-water systems. Newer controls on chillers enable all-variable-flow systems. Check with the manufacturer about minimum flows on chiller evaporators to achieve stable operation over all load ranges.
- All two-way valves must have proper close-off ratings and a design pressure drop of at least 20% of the maximum design pressure drop for controllability. Commercial quality automatic tem-

perature control valves generally have low shutoff ratings; but industrial valves can achieve higher ratings. Three-way control valves should be avoided except to accommodate minimum pump flow and turndown. See Chapter 43 for more information on control valves.

- Although chillers can easily produce colder water, the lower practical limit for chilled-water supply temperatures is 4°C. Temperatures below that should be carefully analyzed for energy usage, although systems with thermal energy storage may operate advantageously at lower temperatures.

3. DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM

3.1 HYDRAULIC CONSIDERATIONS

Objectives of Hydraulic Design

Although the distribution of a thermal utility such as hot water encompasses many of the aspects of domestic hot-water distribution, many dissimilarities also exist; thus the design should not be approached in the same manner. Thermal utilities must supply sufficient energy at the appropriate temperature and pressure to meet consumer needs. Within the constraints imposed by the consumer's end use and equipment, the required thermal energy can be delivered with various combinations of temperature and pressure. Computer-aided design methods are available for thermal piping networks (Bloomquist et al. 1999; COWIconsult 1985; Rasmussen and Lund 1987; Reisman 1985). Using these methods allows rapid evaluation of many alternative designs.

General steam system design can be found in Chapter 11, as well as in IDHA (1983) and Phetteplace et al. (2013). For water systems, see Chapter 13, IDEA (2008b), IDHA (1983), and Phetteplace et al. (2013, 2019).

Water Hammer

The term water hammer is used to describe several phenomena that occur in fluid flow. Although these phenomena differ in nature, they all result in stresses in the piping that are higher than normally encountered. Water hammer can have a disastrous effect on a thermal utility by bursting pipes and fittings and threatening life and property.

In steam systems (IDHA 1983), water hammer is caused primarily by condensate collecting in the bottom of the steam piping. Steam flowing at velocities 10 times greater than normal water flow picks up a slug of condensate and accelerates it to a high velocity. The slug of condensate subsequently collides with the pipe wall at a point where flow changes direction. To prevent this type of water hammer, condensate must be prevented from collecting in steam pipes by using proper steam pipe pitch and adequate condensate collection and return facilities.

Water hammer also occurs in steam systems because of rapid condensation of steam during system warm-up. Rapid condensation decreases the specific volume and pressure of steam, which precipitates pressure shock waves. This form of water hammer is prevented by controlled warm-up of the piping. Valves should be opened slowly and in stages during warm-up. Large steam valves should be provided with smaller bypass valves to slow the warm-up.

Water hammer in hot- and chilled-water distribution systems is caused by sudden changes in flow velocity, which causes pressure shock waves. The two primary causes are pump failure (i.e., power failure) and sudden valve closures. A simplified method to determine maximum resultant pressure may be found in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. More elaborate methods of analysis can be found in Fox (1977), Stephenson (1981), and Streeter and Wylie (1979). Preventive measures include operational procedures and special piping fixtures such as surge columns.

Pressure Losses

Frictional pressure losses occur at the interface between the inner wall of a pipe and a flowing fluid due to shear stresses. In steam systems, these pressure losses are compensated for with increased steam pressure at the point of steam generation. In water systems, pumps are used to increase pressure at either the plant or intermediate points in the distribution system. Calculation of pressure loss is discussed in Chapters 3 and 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Hydraulic calculations reveal that a great deal of the system pressure drop is caused by pipe fittings and offsets; therefore, it is prudent to lay out distribution systems with as few offsets as possible. Some designers prefer two 45° elbows in lieu of a single 90° elbow, assuming that the pressure drop is lower. As pressure drop calculations show, this is not so.

Pipe Sizing

Ideally, the appropriate pipe size should be determined from an economic study of the life-cycle cost for construction and operation. In practice, however, this study is seldom performed because of the effort involved. Instead, criteria that have evolved from practice are frequently used for design. These criteria normally take the form of constraints on the maximum flow velocity or pressure drop. Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* provides velocity and pressure drop constraints. Noise generated by excessive flow velocities is usually not a concern for thermal utility distribution systems outside of buildings. For steam systems, maximum flow velocities of 60 to 75 m/s are recommended (IDHA 1983). For water systems, Europeans use the criterion that pressure losses should be limited to 100 Pa per metre of pipe (Bøhm 1988). Other studies indicate that higher levels of pressure loss may be acceptable (Stewart and Dona 1987) and warranted from an economic standpoint (Bøhm 1986; Koskelainen 1980; Phetteplace 1989). For chilled-water systems (excluding condenser water piping) in buildings, the requirements of ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1-2013 must be followed for water velocity and piping pressure drops.

When establishing design flows for thermal distribution systems, consider the diversity of consumer demands (i.e., the various consumers' maximum demands do not occur at the same time). Thus, the heat supply and main distribution piping may be sized for a maximum load that is somewhat less than the sum of the individual consumers' maximum demands. For steam systems, Geiringer (1963) suggests diversity factors of 0.80 for space heating and 0.65 for domestic hot-water heating and process loads. Geiringer also suggests that these factors may be reduced by approximately 10% for high-temperature water systems. Werner (1984) conducted a study of the heat load on six operating low-temperature hot-water systems in Sweden and found diversity factors ranging from 0.57 to 0.79, with the average being 0.685. Use caution when applying these diversity factors, because the size and number of loads in a system affect the resultant values.

Network Calculations

Calculating flow rates and pressures in a piping network with branches, loops, pumps, and heat exchangers can be difficult without the aid of a computer. Methods have been developed primarily for domestic water distribution systems (Jeppson 1977; Stephenson 1981). These may apply to thermal distribution systems with appropriate modifications. Computer-aided design methods usually incorporate methods for hydraulic analysis as well as for calculating heat losses and delivered water temperature at each consumer. Calculations are usually carried out in an iterative fashion, starting with constant supply and return temperatures throughout the network. After initial estimates of the design flow rates and heat losses are determined, refined estimates of the actual supply temperature at each consumer are computed. Flow rates at each consumer are

then adjusted to ensure that the load is met with the reduced supply temperature, and the calculations are repeated.

Most calculations are performed for a static or steady-state condition and have several input assumptions (e.g., temperatures, pressures, flows, loads) for a specific moment in time. Some computer modeling software packages are dynamic and take real-time inputs of flow and pressure from field instrumentation to efficiently control and optimize the speed of the distribution pumps.

Condensate Drainage and Return in Steam Systems

Condensate forms in operating steam lines as a result of heat loss. When a steam system's operating temperature is increased, condensate also forms as steam warms the piping. At system start-up, these loads usually exceed any operating heat loss loads; thus, special provisions should be made.

To drain the condensate, steam piping should slope toward a collection point called a **drip station**. Drip stations are located in access ports, valve vaults, or buildings where they are accessible for maintenance. Steam piping should slope toward the drip station at least 2 mm/m. If possible, the steam pipe should slope in the same direction as steam flow; otherwise, increase the pipe size to at least one size greater than would normally be used. This reduces the flow velocity of the steam and provides better condensate drainage against the steam flow. Drip stations should be spaced no further than 150 m apart in the absence of other requirements.

Drip stations consist of a short piece of pipe (called a **drip leg**) positioned vertically on the bottom of the steam pipe, as well as a steam trap and appurtenant piping. The drip leg should be the same diameter as the steam pipe. The length of the drip leg should provide a volume equal to 50% of the condensate load from system start-up for steam pipes of 100 mm diameter and larger and 25% of the start-up condensate load for smaller steam pipes (IDHA 1983). Steam traps should be sized to meet the normal load from operational heat losses only. Start-up loads should be accommodated by manual operation of the bypass valve.

Steam traps are used to separate the condensate and noncondensable gases from the steam. For drip stations on steam distribution piping, use inverted bucket or bimetallic thermostatic traps. Some steam traps have integral strainers; others require separate strainers. Ensure that drip leg capacity is adequate when thermostatic traps are used because they always accumulate some condensate.

If it is to be returned, condensate leaving the steam trap flows into the condensate return system. If steam pressure is sufficiently high, it may be used to force the condensate through the condensate return system. With low-pressure steam or on systems where a large pressure exists between drip stations and the ultimate destination of the condensate, condensate receivers and pumps must be provided. High-pressure condensate from drip traps may be sparged into low-pressure condensate mains with a sparge tube (essentially, the high-pressure condensate flashes in the sparge tube).

Schedule 80 steel piping is recommended for condensate lines because of the extra allowance for corrosion it provides. Steam traps have the potential of failing in an open position, thus nonmetallic piping must be protected from live steam where its temperature/pressure would exceed the limitations of the piping. Nonmetallic piping should not be located so close to steam pipes that heat losses from the steam pipes could overheat it. Additional information on condensate removal may be found in Chapter 11. Information on sizing condensate return piping may be found in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

3.2 THERMAL CONSIDERATIONS

Thermal Design Conditions

Three thermal design conditions must be met to ensure satisfactory system performance:

1. The "normal" condition used for the life-cycle cost analysis determines appropriate insulation thickness. Average values for the temperatures, burial depth, and thermal properties of the materials are used for design. If the thermal properties of the insulating material are expected to degrade over the useful life of the system, make appropriate allowances in the cost analysis.
2. Maximum heat transfer rate determines the load on the central plant due to the distribution system. It also determines the temperature drop (or increase, in the case of chilled-water distribution), which determines the delivered temperature to the con sumer. For this calculation, each component's thermal conductivity must be taken at its maximum value, and the temperatures must be assumed to take on their extreme values, which would result in the greatest temperature difference between the carrier medium and the soil or air. The burial depth is normally at its lowest value for this calculation. During operation, none of the thermal capabilities of the materials (or any other materials in the area influenced thermally by the system) must exceed design conditions. To satisfy this objective, each component and the surrounding environment must be examined to determine whether thermal damage is possible. A numerical heat transfer analysis (e.g., finite element) may be necessary in some cases.
3. The conditions of these analyses must be chosen to represent the worst-case scenario from the perspective of the component being examined. For example, in assessing the suitability of a coating material for a metallic conduit, the thermal insulation is assumed to be saturated, the soil moisture is at its lowest probable level, and the burial depth is maximum. These conditions, combined with the highest anticipated pipe and soil temperatures, give the highest conduit surface temperature to which the coating could be exposed.

Heat transfer in buried systems is influenced by the thermal conductivity of the soil and by the depth of burial, particularly when the insulation has low thermal resistance. Soil thermal conductivity changes significantly with moisture content; for example, Bottorf (1951) indicated that soil thermal conductivity ranges from 0.14 W/(m·K) during dry soil conditions to 2.16 W/(m·K) during wet soil conditions.

For details on calculating thermal effects on district energy distribution piping, see Phetteplace et al. (2013, 2019).

Thermal Properties of Pipe Insulation and Soil

Uncertainty in heat transfer calculations for thermal distribution systems results from uncertainty in the thermal properties of materials involved. Generally, the designer must rely on manufacturers' data to obtain approximate values. The data in this chapter should only be used as guidance in preliminary calculations until specific products have been identified; then specific data should be obtained from the manufacturer of the product in question.

Insulation. Insulation provides the primary thermal resistance against heat loss or gain in thermal distribution systems. Thermal properties and other characteristics of insulations normally used in thermal distribution systems are listed in Table 7. Material properties such as thermal conductivity, density, compressive strength, moisture absorption, dimensional stability, and combustibility are typically reported in ASTM standards for the respective material. Some properties have more than one associated standard For example, thermal conductivity for insulation material in block form may be reported using ASTM *Standards* C177, C518, or C1114. For piping containing hot media, thermal conductivity for insulation mate-

Table 7 Comparison of Commonly Used Insulations in Underground Piping Systems

	Calcium Silicate Type I/II ASTM C533	Urethane Foam	Cellular Glass ASTM C552	Mineral Fiber/ Preformed Glass Fiber Type 1 ASTM C547
Thermal conductivity[a] (Values in parentheses are maximum permissible by ASTM standard listed), W/(m·K)				
Mean temp. = 40°C	0.048	0.022	0.057 (0.052)	0.038 (0.036)
90°C	0.054 (0.066/0.078)	0.024	0.067 (0.064)	0.043 (0.045)
150°C	0.059 (0.073/0.083)		0.080 (0.078)	0.048 (0.057)
200°C	0.066 (0.080/0.088)		0.092 (0.093)	(0.074)
Density (max.), kg/m^3	240/360		107 to 147	128 to 176 kg/m^3
Maximum temperature, °C	650	120	430	450
Compressive strength (min.),[b] kg/m^2	100 at 5% deformation		65	N/A
Dimensional stability, linear shrinkage at maximum use temperature	2%		N/A	2%
Flame spread	0		5	25
Smoke index	0		0	50
Water absorption	As-shipped moisture content, 20% max. (by mass)		0.5	Water vapor sorption, 5% max. (by mass)

[a]Thermal conductivity values in this table are from previous editions of this chapter and have been retained as they were used in examples. Thermal conductivity of insulation may vary with temperature, temperature gradient, moisture content, density, thickness, and shape. ASTM maximum values given are comparative for establishing quality control compliance, and are suggested for preliminary calculations where actual values are not available. They may not represent installed performance of insulation under actual conditions that may differ substantially from test conditions. The manufacturer should be able to supply appropriate design values. Phetteplace et al. (2013) contains thermal conductivity data on obsolete insulation materials that are still often found in service.
[b]Compressive strength for cellular glass shown is for flat material, capped as per ASTM *Standard* C240.

Table 8 Effect of Moisture on Underground Piping System Insulations

Characteristics	Polyurethane[a]	Cellular Glass	Mineral Wool[b]	Fibrous Glass
Heating Test	Pipe temp. 1.8 to 127°C Water bath 8 to 38°C	Pipe temp. 1.8 to 215°C Water bath 8 to 38°C	Pipe temp. 1.8 to 230°C Water bath 8 to 38°C	Pipe temp. 1.8 to 230°C Water bath 8 to 38°C
Length of submersion time to reach steady-state *k*-value	70 days	[c]	10 days	2 h
Effective *k*-value increase from dry conditions after steady state achieved in submersion	14 to 19 times at steady state. Estimated water content of insulation 70% (by volume).	Avg. 10 times, process unsteady.[c] Insulation showed evidence of moisture zone on inner diameter.	Up to 50 times at steady state. Insulation completely saturated.	52 to 185 times. Insulation completely saturated at steady state.
Primary heat transfer mechanism	Conduction	[c]	Conduction and convection	Conduction and convection
Length of time for specimen to return to dry steady-state *k*-value after submersion	Pipe at 127°C, after 16 days moisture content 10% (by volume) remaining	Pipe at 215°C, 8 h	Pipe at 230°C, 9 days	Pipe at 193°C, 6 days
Cooling Test	Pipe temp. 2.8°C Water bath at 11°C	Pipe temp. 2.2°C Water bath 8 to 14°C	Pipe temp. 1.8 to 7°C Water bath 13°C	Insulation 1.8 to 230°C Water bath 8 to 38°C
Length of submersion time to reach steady-state conditions for *k*-value	16 days	Data recorded at 4 days constant at 12 days	6 days	1/2 h
Effective *k*-value increase from dry conditions after steady state achieved	2 to 4 times. Water absorption minimal, ceased after 7 days.	None. No water penetration.	14 times. Insulation completely saturated at steady state.	20 times. Insulation completely saturated at steady state.
Primary heat transfer mechanism	Conduction	Conduction	Conduction and convection	Conduction and convection
Length of time for specimen to return to dry steady-state *k*-value after submersion	Pipe at 3.3°C, data curve extrapolated to 10+ days	Pipe at 0.6°C, no change	Pipe at 1.8°C, data curve extrapolated to 25 days	Pipe at 1.8°C, 15 days

Source: Chyu et al. (1997a, 1997b; 1998a, 1998b).
[a]Polyurethane material tested had a density of 46 kg/m^3.
[b]Mineral wool tested was a preformed molded basalt designed for pipe systems operating up to 650°C. It was specially formulated to withstand the Federal Agency Committee (FAC) 96 h boiling water test. See Phetteplace (2013b) for the FAC test protocol.
[c]Cracks formed on heating for all samples of cellular glass insulation tested. Flooded heat loss mechanism involved dynamic two-phase flow of water through cracks; period of dynamic process was about 20 min. Cracks had negligible effect on thermal conductivity of dry cellular glass insulation before and after submersion. No cracks formed during cooling test.

rial fabricated or molded for use on piping is measured using ASTM *Standard* C335.

Chyu et al. (1997a, 1997b, 1998a, 1998b) studied the effect of moisture on the thermal conductivity of insulating materials commonly used in underground district energy systems (ASHRAE research project RP-721). The results are summarized in Table 8. The insulated pipe was immersed in water maintained at 8 to 38°C to simulate possible conduit water temperatures during a failure. The fluid temperature in the insulated pipe ranged from 2 to 230°C. All insulation materials were tested unfaced and/or unjacketed to simulate installation in a conduit.

Table 9 Soil Thermal Conductivities

Soil Moisture Content (by mass)	Thermal Conductivity, W/(m·K)		
	Sand	Silt	Clay
Low, <4%	0.29	0.14	0.14
Medium, 4 to 20%	1.87	1.30	1.00
High, >20%	2.16	2.16	2.16

Painting chilled-water piping before insulating is recommended in areas of high humidity. Insulations used today for chilled water include polyurethane, polyisocyanurate, phenolics, cellular plastics, and fiberglass. No insulation system is totally water- and vaportight; thus, water from the atmosphere can enter the insulation system in small amounts, which can cause corrosion of the pipe. Chloride ions present in most atmospheric water exacerbate corrosion. The best way to minimize corrosion is to make the insulation system highly water resistant by using a closed-cell insulation material coupled with a high-performance vapor retarder, and painting the pipe exterior with a strong rust-preventative coating (two-part epoxy) before insulating. This is good engineering practice and most insulation manufacturers suggest this, but it may not be in their literature. In addition, a good vapor retarder is required on the exterior of the insulation.

When assessing the potential for pipe corrosion under insulation, the pipe operating temperature must be considered. Pipes operating permanently or predominantly at temperatures below about 10°C or above 121°C are not prone to corrosion. Pipes operating between these temperatures, particularly if they are subject to temperature cycling in use or from frequent shutdowns, are most susceptible to corrosion.

Soil. If a soil analysis is available or can be done, the thermal conductivity of the soil can be estimated from published data [e.g., Farouki (1981); Lunardini (1981)]. The thermal conductivity factors in Table 9 may be used as an estimate when detailed information on the soil is not known. Because dry soil is rare in most areas, only assume a low moisture content for system material design, or where it can be validated for calculation of heat losses in the normal operational condition. Values of 1.4 to 1.7 W/(m·K) are commonly used where soil moisture content is unknown. Because moisture migrates toward a chilled pipe, use a thermal conductivity value of 2.16 W/(m·K) for chilled-water systems in the absence of any site-specific soil data. For steady-state analyses, only the thermal conductivity of the soil is required. If a transient analysis is required, the specific heat and density are also required.

3.3 METHODS OF HEAT TRANSFER ANALYSIS

Because heat transfer in piping is not related to the load factor, it can be a large part of the total load. The most important factors affecting heat transfer are the difference between ambient and fluid temperatures and the thermal insulation. For direct-buried piping, the ambient temperature is the earth or soil temperature. For example, the extremes might be a 150 mm, insulated, 200°C water line in 5°C earth with 100 to 200 W/m loss; and a 150 mm, uninsulated, 13°C chilled-water return in 16°C earth with 10 W/m gain. The former requires analysis to determine the required insulation and its effect on the total heating system; the latter suggests analysis and insulation needs might be minimal. Other factors that affect heat transfer are (1) depth of burial, related to the earth temperature and soil thermal resistance; (2) soil thermal conductivity, related to soil moisture content and density; and (3) distance between adjacent pipes.

Computing transient heat gains or losses in underground piping systems requires using numerical methods such as finite element analysis that approximate any physical problem and include factors such as the effect of temperature on thermal properties. For most designs, numerical analyses may not be warranted; one exception is where the potential exists to thermally damage components of the distribution system or something adjacent to it. Also, complex geometries may require numerical analysis. Albert and Phetteplace (1983), Minkowycz et al. (1988), and Rao (1982) have further information on the theory of methods of numerical analysis, and many commercial software packages are available for conducting numerical analyses.

Steady-state calculations are appropriate for determining the annual heat loss/gain from a buried system if average annual earth temperatures are used. Steady-state calculations may also be appropriate for worst-case analyses of thermal effects on materials. Steady-state calculations for a one-pipe system may be done without a computer, but it becomes increasingly difficult for a two-, three-, or four-pipe system.

The following steady-state methods of analysis use resistance formulations developed by Phetteplace and Meyer (1990) that simplify the calculations needed to determine temperatures within the system. Each type of resistance is given a unique subscript and is defined only when introduced. In each case, the resistances are on a unit length basis so that heat flows per unit length result directly when the temperature difference is divided by the resistance.

Calculation of Undisturbed Soil Temperatures

Before any heat loss/gain calculations may be conducted, the undisturbed soil temperature at the site must be determined. The choice of soil temperature is guided primarily by the type of calculation being conducted; see the section on Thermal Design Conditions. For example, if the purpose of the calculation is to determine whether a material will exceed its temperature limit, the maximum expected undisturbed ground temperature is used. The appropriate choice of undisturbed soil temperature also depends on the location of the site, time of year, depth of burial, and thermal properties of the soil. Some methods for determining undisturbed soil temperatures and suggestions on appropriate circumstances to use them are as follows:

1. Use the average annual air or groundwater temperature to approximate the average annual soil temperature. This estimate is appropriate when the objective of the calculation is to yield average heat loss over the yearly weather cycle. Mean annual air temperatures may be obtained from various sources of climatic data (e.g., Chapter 14 of the 2013 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*).
2. Use the maximum/minimum air temperature as an estimate of the maximum/minimum undisturbed soil temperature for pipes buried at a shallow depth. This approximation is an appropriate conservative assumption when checking the temperatures to determine if the temperature limits of any of materials proposed for use will be exceeded. Maximum and minimum expected air temperatures may be calculated from Equations (1) and (2) and setting the depth to zero.
3. For systems that are buried more deeply, maximum/minimum undisturbed soil temperatures may be estimated as a function of depth, soil thermal properties, and prevailing climate. This estimate is appropriate when checking temperatures in a system to determine whether the temperature limits of any of the materials proposed for use will be exceeded. The following equations may be used to estimate the minimum and maximum expected undisturbed soil temperatures:

$$\text{Maximum temperature} = t_{s,z} = t_{ms} + A_s e^{-z\sqrt{\pi/\alpha\tau}} \quad (1)$$

$$\text{Minimum temperature} = t_{s,z} = t_{ms} - A_s e^{-z\sqrt{\pi/\alpha\tau}} \quad (2)$$

where

$t_{s,z}$ = temperature, °C

z = depth, m
τ = annual period, 365 days
α = thermal diffusivity of the ground, m^2/day
t_{ms} = mean annual surface temperature, °C
A_s = surface temperature amplitude, °C

Values for the climatic constants t_{ms} and A_s may be downloaded from tinyurl.com/TC0602ClimateConstants for all worldwide weather stations included in supplemental climate data content accompanying Chapter 14 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* (downloadable from technologyportal.ashrae.org after login).

Thermal diffusivity for soil may be calculated as follows:

$$\alpha = \frac{24 \times 3600 k_s}{1000 \rho_s [c_s + c_w (w/100)]} = \frac{86.4 k_s}{\rho_s [c_s + 4.18 (w/100)]} \quad (3)$$

where

ρ_s = soil density, kg/m^3
c_s = dry soil specific heat, kJ/(kg·K)
c_w = specific heat of water = 4.18 kJ/(kg·K)
w = moisture content of soil, % (dry basis)
k_s = soil thermal conductivity, W/(m·K)

Because the specific heat of dry soil is nearly constant for all types of soil, c_s may be taken as 0.73 kJ/(kg·K).

4. For buried systems, the undisturbed soil temperatures may be estimated for any time of the year as a function of depth, soil thermal properties, and prevailing climate. This temperature may be used in lieu of the soil surface temperature normally called for by the steady-state heat transfer equations when estimates of heat loss/gain as a function of time of year are desired. Substituting the undisturbed soil temperatures at the pipe depth allows the steady-state equations to be used as a first approximation to the solution to the actual transient heat transfer problem with its annual temperature variations at the surface. The following equation may be used to estimate the undisturbed soil temperature at any depth at any point during the yearly weather cycle (ASCE 1996). (*Note*: The argument for the sine function is in radians.)

$$t_{s,z} = t_{ms} - A_s e^{-z\sqrt{\pi/\alpha\tau}} \sin\left[\frac{2\pi(\theta - \theta_{lag})}{\tau} - z\sqrt{\frac{\pi}{\alpha\tau}}\right] \quad (4)$$

where

θ = Julian date, days
θ_{lag} = phase lag of soil surface temperature, days

Use Equation (3) to calculate soil thermal diffusivity. Values for the climatic constants t_{ms}, A_s, and θ_{lag} may be found at tinyurl.com/TC0602ClimateConstants for all worldwide weather stations included in the supplemental climate data content accompanying Chapter 14 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* (downloadable from technologyportal.ashrae.org after login). Phetteplace et al. (2013) contains equations that may be used to calculate the climatic constants for any weather data set, real or contrived.

Equation (4) does not account for latent heat effects from freezing, thawing, or evaporation. However, for soil adjacent to a buried heat distribution system, the equation provides a good estimate, because heat losses from the system tend to prevent the adjacent ground from freezing. For buried chilled-water systems, freezing may be a consideration; therefore, systems that are not used or drained during the winter months should be buried below the seasonal frost depth. For simplicity, the ground surface temperature is assumed to equal the air temperature, which is an acceptable assumption for most design calculations. If a more accurate calculation is desired, use the following method to compensate for the convective thermal resistance to heat transfer at the ground surface.

Convective Heat Transfer at Ground Surface

Heat transfer between the ground surface and the ambient air occurs by convection. In addition, heat transfer with the soil occurs due to precipitation and radiation. The heat balance at the ground surface is too complex to warrant detailed treatment in the design of buried district heating and cooling systems. However, in some circumstances, approximations that included impacts beyond an average convective heat transfer coefficient were found. For example, McCabe et al. (1995) observed significant temperature variations caused by the type of surfaces over district heating and cooling systems. Phetteplace et al. (2019) contains methods to approximate the impacts of surface type.

Normally, only convection is considered, and as a first approximation, an **effective thickness** of a fictitious soil layer may be added to the burial depth to account for the effect of the convective heat transfer resistance at the ground surface. The effective thickness is calculated as follows:

$$\delta = k_s / h \quad (5)$$

where

δ = effective thickness of fictitious soil layer, m
k_s = thermal conductivity of soil, W/(m·K)
h = convective heat transfer coefficient at ground surface, $W/(m^2 \cdot K)$

The effective thickness calculated with Equation (5) is simply added to the actual burial depth of the pipes in calculating the soil thermal resistance using Equations (6), (7), (20), (21), and (27).

Uninsulated Buried Pipe

For this case (Figure 7), an estimate for soil thermal resistance may be used. This estimate is sufficiently accurate (within 1%) for the ratios of burial depth to pipe radius indicated next to Equations (6) and (7). Both the actual resistance and the approximate resistance are presented, along with the depth/radius criteria for each.

$$R_s = \frac{\ln\{(d/r_o) + [(d/r_o)^2 - 1]^{1/2}\}}{2\pi k_s} \quad \text{for } d/r_o > 2 \quad (6)$$

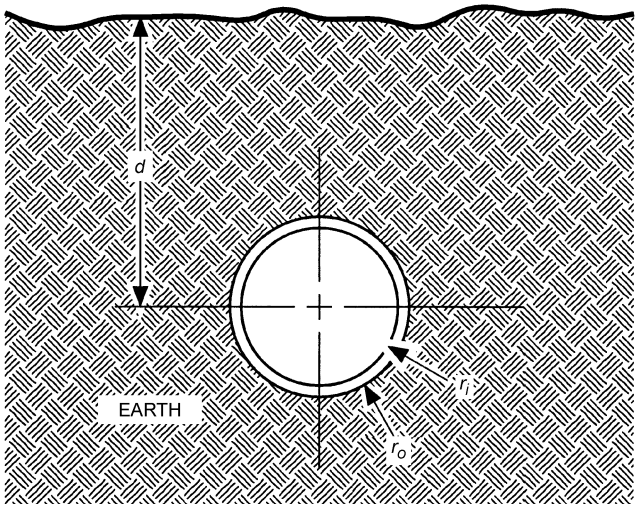


Fig. 8 Uninsulated Buried Pipe

$$R_s = \frac{\ln(2d/r_o)}{2\pi k_s} \qquad \text{for } d/r_o > 4 \tag{7}$$

where

R_s = thermal resistance of soil, (m·K)/W
k_s = thermal conductivity of soil, W/(m·K)
d = burial depth to centerline of pipe, m
r_o = outer radius of pipe or conduit, m

The pipe's thermal resistance is included if it is significant compared to the soil resistance. The thermal resistance of a pipe or any concentric circular region is given by

$$R_p = \frac{\ln(r_o/r_i)}{2\pi k_p} \tag{8}$$

where

R_p = thermal resistance of pipe wall, (m·K)/W
k_p = thermal conductivity of pipe, W/(m·K)
r_i = inner radius of pipe, m

Example 3. Consider an uninsulated, 75 mm Schedule 40 PVC chilled-water supply line carrying 7°C water. Assume the pipe is buried 1 m deep in soil with a thermal conductivity of 1.7 W/(m·K), and no other pipes or thermal anomalies are in close proximity. Assume the average annual soil temperature is 15°C.

r_i = 39.1 mm = 0.0391 m
r_o = 44.5 mm = 0.0445 m
d = 1 m
k_s = 1.7 W/(m·K)
k_p = 0.17 W/(m·K)

Solution: Calculate the thermal resistance of the pipe using Equation (8):

$$R_p = 0.12 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

Calculate the thermal resistance of the soil using Equation (7). [*Note*: $d/r_o = 22$ is greater than 4; thus Equation (7) may be used in lieu of Equation (6).]

$$R_s = 0.36 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

Calculate the rate of heat transfer by dividing the overall temperature difference by the total thermal resistance:

$$q = \frac{t_f - t_s}{R_t} = \frac{(7 - 15)}{(0.12 + 0.36)} = -17 \text{ W/m}$$

where

R_t = total thermal resistance, (i.e., $R_s + R_p$ in this case of pure series heat flow), (m·K)/W
t_f = fluid temperature, °C
t_s = average annual soil temperature, °C
q = heat loss or gain per unit length of system, W/m

The negative result indicates a heat gain rather than a loss. Note that the thermal resistance of the fluid/pipe interface has been neglected, which is a reasonable assumption because such resistances tend to be very small for flowing fluids. Also note that, in this case, the thermal resistance of the pipe comprises a significant portion of the total thermal resistance. This results from the relatively low thermal conductivity of PVC compared to other piping materials and the fact that no other major thermal resistances exist in the system to overshadow it. If any significant amount of insulation were included in the system, its thermal resistance would dominate, and it might be possible to neglect that of the piping material.

Insulated Buried Pipe

Equation (8) can be used to calculate the thermal resistance of any concentric circular region of material, including an insulation layer. When making calculations using insulation thickness, use actual rather than nominal thickness to obtain the most accurate results.

Example 4. Consider the effect of adding 25 mm of urethane foam insulation and a 3 mm thick PVC jacket to the chilled-water line in Example 3. Calculate the thermal resistance of the insulation layer from Equation (8) as follows:

$$R_i = \frac{\ln[(44.5 + 25)/44.5]}{2\pi \times 0.021} = 3.38 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

For the PVC jacket material, use Equation (8) again:

$$R_j = \frac{\ln[(3 + 44.5 + 25)/(44.5 + 25)]}{2\pi \times 0.17} = 0.04 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The thermal resistance of the soil as calculated by Equation (7) decreases slightly to $R_s = 0.31$ (m·K)/W because of the increase in the outer radius of the piping system. The total thermal resistance is now

$$R_t = R_p + R_i + R_j + R_s = 0.12 + 3.38 + 0.04 + 0.31 = 3.85 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

Heat gain by the chilled-water pipe is reduced to about 2 W/m. In this case, the thermal resistance of the piping material and the jacket material could be neglected with a resultant error of <5%. Considering that the uncertainties in the material properties are likely greater than 5%, it is usually appropriate to neglect minor resistances such as those of piping and jacket materials if insulation is present.

Buried Pipe in Conduit with Air Space

Systems with air spaces (Figure 9) may be treated by adding an appropriate resistance for the air space. For simplicity, assume a heat transfer coefficient of 17 W/(m^2·K) (based on the outer surface area of the insulation), which applies in most cases. The resistance caused by this heat transfer coefficient is then

$$R_a = 1/(17 \times 2\pi \times r_{oi}) = 0.0094/r_{oi} \tag{9}$$

where

r_{oi} = outer radius of insulation, m
R_a = resistance of air space, (m·K)/W

A more precise value for the resistance of an air space can be developed with empirical relations available for convection in enclosures such as those given by Grober et al. (1961). Consider the effect of radiation in the annulus when high temperatures are expected in the air space. For the treatment of radiation, refer to Siegel and Howell (1981).

Example 5. Consider a 150 mm nominal diameter (168 mm outer diameter or 84 mm radius) high-temperature water line operating at 190°C. Assume the pipe is insulated with 65 mm of mineral wool with a ther-

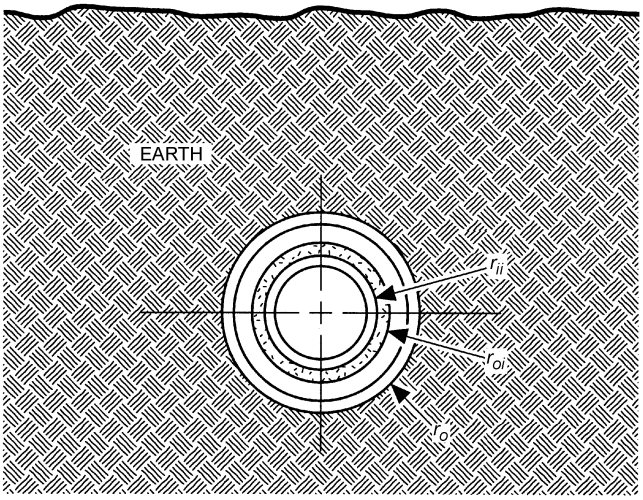


Fig. 9 Insulated Buried Pipe with Air Space

mal conductivity k_i = 0.045 W/(m·K) at 100°C and k_i = 0.052 W/(m·K) at 150°C.

The pipe is encased in a steel conduit with a concentric air gap of 25 mm. The steel conduit is 3 mm thick and has a corrosion resistant coating approximately 3 mm thick. The pipe is buried 1.2 m deep to pipe centerline in soil with an average annual temperature of 15°C. The soil thermal conductivity is assumed to be 1.7 W/(m·K). Thermal resistances of the pipe, conduit, and conduit coating will be neglected.

Solution: Calculate the thermal resistance of the pipe insulation. To do so, assume a mean insulation temperature of 120°C to establish its thermal conductivity, which is equivalent to assuming the insulation outer surface temperature is 50°C. Interpolating the data listed previously, insulation thermal conductivity k_i = 0.048 W/(m·K). Then calculate insulation thermal resistance using Equation (8):

$$R_i = \frac{\ln[(84+65)/84]}{2\pi \times 0.048} = 1.90 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

Calculate the thermal resistance of the air space using Equation (9):

$$R_a = 1/[107(84+65) \times 10^{-3}] = 0.06 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

Calculate the thermal resistance of the soil from Equation (7):

$$R_s = \frac{\ln[2 \times 1.2/(180 \times 10^{-3})]}{2\pi \times 1.7} = 0.24 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The total thermal resistance is

$$R_t = R_i + R_a + R_s = 1.90 + 0.06 + 0.24 = 2.20 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The first estimate of the heat loss is then

$$q = (190 - 15)/2.20 = 79.5 \text{ W/m}$$

Now repeat the calculation with an improved estimate of the mean insulation temperature obtained, and calculate the outer surface temperature as

$$t_{io} = t_{po} - (qR_i) = 190 - (79.5 \times 1.90) = 39°C$$

where t_{po} = outer surface temperature of pipe, °C.

The new estimate of the mean insulation temperature is 115°C, which is close to the original estimate. Thus, the insulation thermal conductivity changes only slightly, and the resulting thermal resistance is R_i = 1.94 (m·K)/W. Other thermal resistances in the system remain unchanged, and the heat loss becomes q = 78.1 W/m. The insulation surface temperature is now approximately t_{io} = 38°C, and no further calculations are needed.

Buried Pipe with Composite Insulation

Many systems use more than one insulating material. The motivation for doing so is usually to use an insulation that has desirable thermal properties or lower cost, but it is unable to withstand the service temperature of the carrier pipe (e.g., polyurethane foam). Another insulation with acceptable service temperature limits (e.g., calcium silicate or mineral wool) is normally placed adjacent to the carrier pipe in sufficient thickness to reduce the temperature at its outer surface to below the limit of the insulation that is desirable to use (e.g., urethane foam). Calculation of the heat loss and/or temperature in a composite system is straightforward using the equations presented previously. The following two examples show calculation of both heat losses and temperatures of interest in such systems.

Example 6. A high-temperature water line operating at 200°C is installed in southern Texas. It consists of a 150 mm nominal diameter (84 mm outer radius) carrier pipe insulated with 40 mm of calcium silicate. In addition, 25 mm polyurethane foam insulation is placed around the calcium silicate insulation. The polyurethane insulation is encased in a 13 mm thick fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) jacket. The piping system is buried 3 m deep to the pipe centerline. Neglect the thermal resistances of the pipe and FRP jacket.

Calcium silicate thermal conductivity
- 0.066 W/(m·K) at 100°C
- 0.073 W/(m·K) at 150°C
- 0.080 W/(m·K) at 200°C

Polyurethane foam thermal conductivity
- 0.022 W/(m·K) at 40°C
- 0.024 W/(m·K) at 90°C
- 0.026 W/(m·K) at 135°C

Assumed soil properties
- Thermal conductivity = 0.35 W/(m·K)
- Density (dry soil) = 1680 kg/m^3
- Moisture content = 5% (dry basis)

What is the maximum operating temperature of the polyurethane foam insulation?

Solution: Because the maximum operating temperature of the materials is sought, the maximum expected, rather than the average annual, soil temperature must be found. Also, the lowest anticipated soil thermal conductivity and deepest burial depth are assumed. These conditions produce the maximum internal temperatures of the components.

To solve the problem, first calculate the maximum soil temperature expected at the installation depth using Equation (1). Assume the following values for climatic constants for this region as t_{ms} = 22.1°C and A_s = 8.3 K (see tinyurl.com/TC0602Climate
Constants for climatic data constants). Estimate soil thermal diffusivity using Equation (3).

$$\alpha = \frac{86.4 \times 0.35}{1680[0.73 + 4.18(5/100)]} = 0.019 \text{ m}^2\text{/day}$$

Then use Equation (1) to calculate the maximum soil temperature at the installation depth as follows:

$$t_{s,z} = 22.1 + 8.3 \exp\left[-3\sqrt{\frac{\pi}{0.019 \times 365}}\right] = 23.2°C$$

Now calculate the first estimates of the thermal resistances of the pipe insulations. For calcium silicate, assume a mean temperature of the insulation of 150°C to establish its thermal conductivity. From the data listed previously, calcium silicate's thermal conductivity k_i = 0.073 W/(m·K) at this temperature. For the polyurethane foam, assume the insulation's mean temperature is 90°C. From the data listed previously, the polyurethane foam's thermal conductivity k_i = 0.024 W/(m·K) at this temperature. Now calculate the insulation thermal resistances using Equation (8):

$$\text{Calcium silicate } R_{i,1} = \frac{\ln[(0.040+0.084)/0.084]}{2\pi(0.073)} = 0.85 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

$$\text{Polyurethane foam } R_{i,2} = \frac{\ln[(0.124+0.025)/0.124]}{2\pi(0.024)} = 1.22 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

Calculate the thermal resistance of the soil from Equation (7):

$$R_s = \frac{\ln[2 \times 3/(0.084+0.040+0.025+0.013)]}{2\pi(0.35)} = 1.64 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The total thermal resistance is

$$R_t = 0.85 + 1.22 + 1.64 = 3.71 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The first estimate of the heat loss is then

$$q = (200 - 23.2)/3.71 = 47.7 \text{ W/m}$$

Next, calculate the estimated insulation surface temperature with this first estimate of the heat loss. Find the temperature at the interface between the calcium silicate and polyurethane foam insulations.

$$t_{io,1} = t_{po} - qR_{i,1} = 200 - (47.7 \times 0.85) = 159°C$$

where t_{po} is the outer surface temperature of the pipe and $t_{io,1}$ is the outer surface temperature of first insulation (calcium silicate).

$$t_{io,2} = t_{po} - q(R_{i,1} + R_{i,2}) = 200 - 47.7(0.85 + 1.22) = 101°C$$

where $t_{io,2}$ is the outer surface temperature of second insulation (polyurethane foam).

The new estimate of the mean insulation temperature is (200 + 159)/2 = 180°C for the calcium silicate and (159 + 101)/2 = 130°C for the polyurethane foam. Thus, the insulation thermal conductivity for the calcium silicate is interpolated to be 0.077 W/(m·K), and the resulting thermal resistance is $R_{i,1}$ = 0.81 (m·K)/W.

For the polyurethane foam insulation, the thermal conductivity is interpolated to be 0.026 W/(m·K), and the resulting thermal resistance is $R_{i,2}$ = 1.12 (m·K)/W. The soil thermal resistance remains unchanged, and the heat loss is recalculated as q = 49.5 W/m.

The calcium silicate insulation outer surface temperature is now approximately $t_{io,1}$ = 160°C, and the outer surface temperature of the polyurethane foam is calculated to be $t_{io,2}$ = 104°C. Because these temperatures are within a few degrees of those calculated previously, no further calculations are needed.

Table 10 Effect of Interior Insulation Thickness on Exterior Insulation Temperature (Example 7)

Insulation Thickness, mm				Thermal Resistances, (m·K)/W						
Mineral Wool	Urethane Foam	Air Space, mm	Burial Depth, m	Mineral Wool	Air Space	Urethane Foam	Soil	Heat Loss, W/m	Foam Maximum Temp., °C	HPDE Casing Temp., °C
38.1	25.4	25.4	3.05	0.881	0.0764	0.960	1.61	51.3	155	106
63.5	25.4	25.4	3.05	1.38	0.0632	0.848	1.55	47.1	136	96.4
76.2	25.4	25.4	3.05	1.61	0.0582	0.801	1.53	45.4	129	92.4
88.9	25.4	25.4	3.05	1.82	0.0540	0.760	1.50	43.8	122	88.9
102	25.4	25.4	3.05	2.03	0.0503	0.722	1.48	42.4	116	85.7

Table 11 Effects of Soil Thermal Conductivity and Burial Depth on Exterior Insulation Temperature (Example 7)

Soil Thermal Conductivity, W/(m·K)	Insulation Thickness, mm		Air Space, mm	Burial Depth, m	Thermal Resistances, (m·K)/W				Heat Loss, W/m	Foam Maximum Temp., °C	HDPE Casing Temp., °C
	Mineral Wool	Urethane Foam			Mineral Wool	Air Space	Urethane Foam	Soil			
0.35	102	25.4	25.4	3.05	2.03	0.0503	0.722	1.48	42.4	116	85.7
1.4	50.8	25.4	25.4	3.05	1.20	0.0692	0.951	0.396	69.2	116	50.6
0.35	88.9	25.4	25.4	1.52	1.85	0.0540	0.769	1.18	47.0	115	78.7
1.4	50.8	25.4	25.4	1.52	1.21	0.0692	0.956	0.316	71.0	114	45.6
0.35	102	50.8	25.4	3.05	1.98	0.0503	1.37	1.43	37.5	128	76.9

The maximum temperature of the polyurethane insulation of 160°C occurs at its inner surface (i.e., the interface with the calcium silicate insulation). This temperature clearly exceeds the maximum accepted 30-year service temperature of polyurethane foam of 120°C (CEN *Standard* EN 253). Thus, the amount of calcium silicate insulation needs to be increased significantly to achieve a maximum temperature for the polyurethane foam insulation within its long-term service temperature limit. Under the conditions of this example, it would take about 125 mm of calcium silicate insulation to reduce the insulation interface temperature to less than 120°C.

Example 7 examines the effects of soil thermal conductivity and decreasing burial depth for a system with composite insulation and an air space.

Example 7. As in Example 6, assume a high-temperature water line operating at 200°C installed in southern Texas. Here it also consists of a 150 mm nominal diameter (84 mm outer radius) insulated carrier pipe, but the first layer of insulation is initially proposed to be 40 mm of mineral wool. The carrier pipe and mineral wool insulation are contained inside a 3.2 mm thick steel conduit with a 25 mm air space between the insulation exterior and the conduit interior. On the exterior of the steel conduit is 25 mm polyurethane foam insulation. The polyurethane insulation is encased in a 6.4 mm thick high-density polyethylene (HDPE) jacket. The piping system is buried 3 m deep to the pipe centerline. The initial assumption for the burial depth and soil thermal properties is the same as those used in Example 6, but the effect of those design parameters will be examined. Neglect the thermal resistances of the pipe, conduit, and HDPE jacket.

Mineral wool thermal conductivity
- 0.045 W/(m·K) at 90°C
- 0.057 W/(m·K) at 150°C
- 0.074 W/(m·K) at 200°C

Polyurethane foam thermal conductivity
- 0.022 W/(m·K) at 40°C
- 0.024 W/(m·K) at 90°C
- 0.026 W/(m·K) at 135°C

Assumed soil properties
- Thermal conductivity = 0.35 W/(m·K)
- Density (dry soil) = 1680 kg/m^3
- Moisture content = 5% (dry basis)

What is the maximum operating temperature of the polyurethane foam insulation and the HDPE jacket?

Solution: As in Example 6, the maximum operating temperature of the materials is sought; thus, the maximum expected soil temperature rather than the average annual soil temperature must be used, along with the lowest anticipated soil thermal conductivity and the deepest burial depth. The effect of these design parameters will be explored briefly once the proposed design has been evaluated. Calculation of the thermal resistances of the insulations, soil, and air space follow the methods outlined in Examples 5 and 6 and thus are not repeated here in detail. Table 10 summarizes results from the calculation as well as the final results for the thermal resistances after three iterations.

As shown in Table 10, for the design initially proposed with 38 mm of mineral wool insulation, the maximum temperature of the urethane foam (at its interface with the steel casing) is 155°C. This clearly exceeds the long-term temperature capabilities of urethane foam. Additionally, note that the temperature of the HDPE casing would be 106°C, which would likely be well in excess of its capabilities, as well. Table 7 provides results for other thicknesses of the mineral wool insulation; as can be seen from these results, it would require 100 mm of mineral wool insulation to reduce the maximum temperature seen by the urethane foam to within its 121°C limit for long-term exposure. Even with this insulation thickness, the HDPE casing temperature would be at 85.7°C, which could be problematic depending on the HDPE formulation. As will be shown by the following calculations, the casing temperature could be reduced by adding thickness to the urethane insulation. However, this has the unfortunate consequence of increasing the maximum temperature of the urethane insulation, in the absence of any other changes to the design.

The burial depth and soil thermal conductivity in this example and Example 6 could be considered extreme; however, they are encountered in practice. In fact, deeper burials have not been entirely infrequent in practice and the results of these heat transfer calculations should only reinforce the cautions later in this chapter regarding deep burial. Low soil thermal conductivity may result not just from low rainfall and deep water tables, but also soil type and the impact of the constant heat loss from the buried heat distribution system. Table 11 shows the effects of soil thermal conductivity and burial depth on the design of this example.

Table 11 contains the results of several calculations with increased soil thermal conductivity and reduced burial depth. For each of these cases, the thickness of the mineral wool insulation has been adjusted in 12.7 mm increments to find the minimum mineral wool insulation thickness to reduce the maximum temperature of the polyurethane insulation to or below 121°C. The results show that, where soil conditions result in the soil thermal conductivity being increased to 1.4 W/(m·K), the thickness of the mineral wool insulation may be reduced from 100 mm to 50 mm. Where the soil conditions result in a thermal conductivity of 0.35 W/(m·K), as was the case in the original calculation of the example, if the burial depth is decreased from 3.05 m to 1.52 m, the thickness of the mineral wool insulation may be reduced only by 12.7 mm, to 88.9 mm. For a case with both lower burial depth and high soil thermal conductivity, the thickness of the mineral wool insulation still must be 50 mm; thus, the decrease in burial depth from 3.05 m to 1.52 m results in slightly lower maximum temperature for the urethane foam but no net reduction in the mineral wool insulation thickness required.

The last column in Table 11 shows how increasing the thickness of the polyurethane insulation affects the temperature of the HDPE jacket. Although adding 25 mm of urethane insulation to bring its thickness to 50 mm reduces the maximum temperature of the HDPE jacket from 85.7°C to 76.9°C, it increases the maximum temperature of the urethane foam insulation from 116°C to 128°C, above the accepted limit of 121°C.

Note that all of the calculations in Examples 6 and 7 are based on the assumption of a single, insulated buried pipe. Where supply and return lines are buried side by side and both are operating above the surrounding soil temperature, heat losses will be reduced but the temperature of system components will be elevated. The effect can be considered as somewhat analogous to burying the pipelines in a region with higher soil temperatures, which of course also reduces their heat loss. The formulation for calculating heat losses for adjacent supply and return lines presented later in this chapter does not allow for direct calculation of system temperatures. As an approximation, it is suggested that the individual heat losses for the supply pipe, where the limiting condition will occur, be first calculated using Equations (18) to (25) (shown in Example 9). To approximate the system temperatures, use the methods outlined in this example as if the pipeline were buried by itself, but adjust the soil temperature upward to achieve the same rate of heat loss as determined by Equations (18) to (25) for the supply pipe in the supply and return configuration. This somewhat underestimates the impacts of the adjacent return pipeline, so be conservative when using this method.

Examples 6 and 7 show the need to fully consider burial conditions when assessing systems that have limitations on any of their component temperatures that are below the carrier fluid's operating temperature. Although the examples here are from systems with multiple insulations with temperature limitation on one of the insulations, this consideration also applies to any system, with or without composite insulation. Nonmetallic jacket materials as well as corrosion-resistant coatings are other examples of materials that often have temperature limitations well below carrier pipe temperatures encountered in practice. Deep burial of systems and/or burial of systems in low-thermal-conductivity soil requires that calculations such as those from Examples 6 and 7 be conducted where materials with temperature limitations below the carrier pipe temperature exist.

Two Pipes Buried in Common Conduit with Air Space

For this case (Figure 10), make the same assumption as made in the Buried Pipe in Conduit with Air Space section. For convenience, add some of the thermal resistances as follows:

$$R_1 = R_{p1} + R_{i1} + R_{a1} \tag{10}$$

$$R_2 = R_{p2} + R_{i2} + R_{a2} \tag{11}$$

Subscripts 1 and 2 differentiate between the two pipes within the conduit. The combined heat loss is then given by

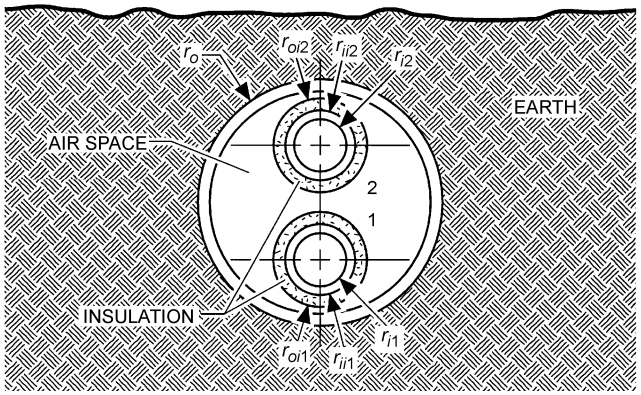


Fig. 10 Two Pipes Buried in Common Conduit with Air Space

$$q = \frac{[(t_{f1} - t_s)/R_1] + \left[(t_{f2} - t_s)/R_2\right]}{1 + (R_{cs}/R_1) + (R_{cs}/R_2)} \tag{12}$$

where R_{cs} is the total thermal resistance of conduit shell and soil.

Once the combined heat flow is determined, calculate the bulk temperature in the air space:

$$t_a = t_s + qR_{cs} \tag{13}$$

Then calculate the insulation outer surface temperature:

$$t_{i1} = t_a + (t_{f1} - t_a)(R_{a1}/R_1) \tag{14}$$

$$t_{i2} = t_a + (t_{f2} - t_a)(R_{a2}/R_2) \tag{15}$$

The heat flows from each pipe are given by

$$q_1 = (t_{f1} - t_a)/R_1 \tag{16}$$

$$q_2 = (t_{f2} - t_a)/R_2 \tag{17}$$

When the insulation thermal conductivity is a function of its temperature, as is usually the case, an iterative calculation is required, as shown in the following example.

Example 8. A pair of 100 mm NPS medium-temperature hot-water supply and return lines run in a common 530 mm outside diameter conduit. Assume that the supply temperature is 160°C and the return temperature is 100°C. The supply pipe is insulated with 60 mm of mineral wool insulation, and the return pipe has 50 mm of mineral wool insulation. The insulation's thermal conductivity is 0.038 W/(m·K) at 50°C. The pipe is buried 1.25 m to centerline in soil with a thermal conductivity of 1.7 W/(m·K). Assume the thermal resistance of the pipe, the conduit, and the conduit coating are negligible. As a first estimate, assume the bulk air temperature within the conduit is 40°C. In addition, use this temperature as a first estimate of the insulation surface temperatures to obtain the mean insulation temperatures and subsequent insulation thermal conductivities.

Solution: By interpolation, estimate the insulation thermal conductivities from the data given in Example 5 at 0.045 W/(m·K) for the supply pipe and 0.041 W/(m·K) for the return pipe. Calculate the thermal resistances using Equations (10) and (11):

$$R_1 = R_{i1} + R_{a1} = \ln(0.117/0.057)/(2\pi \times 0.045) + 0.0094/0.117$$
$$= 2.54 + 0.08 = 2.62 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

$$R_2 = R_{i2} + R_{a2} = \ln(0.041) + 0.0094/0.107$$
$$= 2.44 + 0.09 = 2.53 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

$$R_{cs} = R_s = \ln[2 \times 1.25/(0.53/2)]/(2\pi \times 1.7) = 0.210 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

Calculate first estimate of combined heat flow from Equation (12):

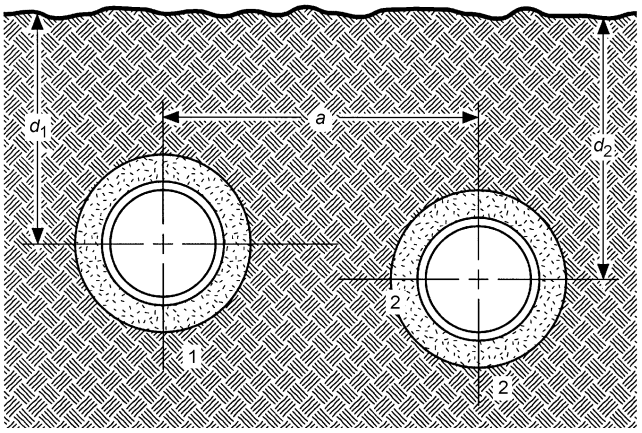


Fig. 11 Two Buried Pipes or Conduits

$$q = \frac{(160 - 15)/2.62 + (100 - 15)/2.53}{1 + (0.210/2.62) + (0.210/2.53)} = 76.5 \text{ W/m}$$

Estimate bulk air temperature in the conduit with Equation (13):

$$t_a = 15 + (76.5 \times 0.210) = 31.1°\text{C}$$

Then revise estimates of the insulation surface temperatures with Equations (14) and (15):

$$t_{t1} = 31.1 + (160 - 31.1)(0.08/2.62) = 35.0°\text{C}$$
$$t_{t2} = 31.1 + (100 - 31.1)(0.09/2.53) = 33.6°\text{C}$$

These insulation surface temperatures are close enough to the original estimate of 40°C that further iterations are not warranted. If the individual supply and return heat losses are desired, calculate them using Equations (16) and (17).

Two Buried Pipes or Conduits

This case (Figure 11) may be formulated in terms of the thermal resistances used for a single buried pipe or conduit and some correction factors. The correction factors needed are

$$\theta_1 = (t_{p2} - t_s)/(t_{p1} - t_s) \tag{18}$$

$$\theta_2 = 1/\theta_1 = (t_{p1} - t_s)/(t_{p2} - t_s) \tag{19}$$

$$P_1 = \frac{1}{2\pi k_s} \ln \left[\frac{(d_1 + d_2)^2 + a^2}{(d_1 - d_2)^2 + a^2} \right]^{0.5} \tag{20}$$

$$P_2 = \frac{1}{2\pi k_s} \ln \left[\frac{(d_2 + d_1)^2 + a^2}{(d_2 - d_1)^2 + a^2} \right]^{0.5} \tag{21}$$

where a = horizontal separation distance between centerline of two pipes, m.

The thermal resistance for each pipe or conduit is given by

$$R_{e1} = \frac{R_{t1} - (P_1^2/R_{t2})}{1 - (P_1\theta_1/R_{t2})} \tag{22}$$

$$R_{e2} = \frac{R_{t2} - (P_2^2/R_{t1})}{1 - (P_2\theta_2/R_{t1})} \tag{23}$$

where

θ = temperature correction factor, dimensionless
P = geometric/material correction factor, (m·K)/W
R_e = effective thermal resistance of one pipe/conduit in two-pipe system, (m·K)/W
R_t = total thermal resistance of one pipe/conduit if buried separately, (m·K)/W

Heat flow from each pipe is then calculated from

$$q_1 = (t_{p1} - t_s)/R_{e1} \tag{24}$$

$$q_2 = (t_{p2} - t_s)/R_{e2} \tag{25}$$

Example 9. Consider buried supply and return lines for a low-temperature hot-water system. The carrier pipes are 100 mm NPS (112 mm outer diameter) with 40 mm of urethane foam insulation. The insulation is protected by a 6 mm thick PVC jacket. The thermal conductivity of the insulation is 0.023 W/(m·K) and is assumed constant with respect to temperature. The pipes are buried 1.2 m deep to the centerline in soil with a thermal conductivity of 1.7 W/(m·K) and a mean annual temperature of 15°C. The horizontal distance between the pipe centerlines is 600 mm. The supply water is at 120°C, and the return water is at 65°C.

Solution: Neglect the thermal resistances of the carrier pipes and the PVC jacket. First, calculate the resistances from Equations (7) and (8) as if the pipes were independent of each other:

$$R_{s1} = R_{s2} = \frac{\ln[(2 \times 1.2)/(102 \times 10^{-3})]}{2\pi \times 1.7} = 0.30 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

$$R_{i1} = R_{i2} = \frac{\ln[(112/2 + 40)/56]}{2\pi \times 0.023} = 3.73 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

$$R_{t1} = R_{t2} = 0.30 + 3.73 = 4.03 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

From Equations (20) and (21), the correction factors are

$$P_1 = P_2 = \frac{1}{2\pi \times 1.7} \ln \left[\frac{(1.2 + 1.2)^2 + 0.6^2}{(1.2 - 1.2)^2 + 0.6^2} \right]^{0.5} = 0.133 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

$$\theta_1 = (65 - 15)/(120 - 15) = 0.476$$

$$\theta_2 = 1/\theta_1 = 2.10$$

Calculate the effective total thermal resistances as

$$R_{e1} = \frac{4.03 - (0.133^2/4.03)}{1 - (0.133 \times 0.476/4.03)} = 4.09 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

$$R_{e2} = \frac{4.03 - (0.133^2/4.03)}{1 - (0.133 \times 2.10/4.03)} = 4.33 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The heat flows are then

$$q_1 = (120 - 15)/4.09 = 25.7 \text{ W/m}$$

$$q_2 = (65 - 15)/4.33 = 211.5 \text{ W/m}$$

$$q_t = 25.7 + 11.5 = 37.2 \text{ W/m}$$

Note that when the resistances and geometry for the two pipes are identical, the total heat flow from the two pipes is the same if the temperature corrections are used or if they are set to unity. The individual losses vary somewhat, however. These equations may also be used with air space systems. When the thermal conductivity of the pipe insulation is a function of temperature, iterative calculations must be done.

Pipes in Buried Trenches or Tunnels

Buried rectangular trenches or tunnels (Figure 12) require several assumptions to obtain approximate solutions for the heat transfer. First, assume that air within the tunnel or trench is uniform in temperature and that the same is true for the inside surface of the trench/tunnel walls. Field measurements by Phetteplace et al. (1991) on operating shallow trenches indicate maximum spatial air temperature variations of about 6 K. Air temperature variations of this magnitude in a tunnel or trench do not cause significant errors

for normal operating temperatures when using the following calculation methods.

Unless numerical methods are used, the resistance of a rectangular region such as the walls of a trench or tunnel must be approximated. One procedure is to assume linear heat flow through the trench or tunnel walls, which yields the following resistance for the walls (Phetteplace et al. 1981):

$$R_w = \frac{x_w}{2k_w(a+b)} \tag{26}$$

where

R_w = thermal resistance of trench/tunnel walls, (m·K)/W
x_w = thickness of trench/tunnel walls, m
a = width of trench/tunnel inside, m
b = height of trench/tunnel inside, m
k_w = thermal conductivity of trench/tunnel wall material, W/(m·K)

As an alternative to Equation (26), the thickness of the trench/tunnel walls may be included in the soil burial depth. This approximation is only acceptable when the thermal conductivity of the trench/tunnel wall material is similar to that of the soil.

The thermal resistance of the soil surrounding the buried trench/tunnel is calculated using the following equation (Rohsenow 1998):

$$R_{ts} = \frac{\ln[3.5d/(b_o^{0.75}a_o^{0.25})]}{k_s[(a_o/2b_o)+5.7]} \qquad a_o > b_o \tag{27}$$

where

R_{ts} = thermal resistance of soil surrounding trench/tunnel, (m·K)/W
a_o = width of trench/tunnel outside, m
b_o = height of trench/tunnel outside, m
d = burial depth of trench to centerline, m

Equations (26) and (27) can be combined with the equations already presented to calculate heat flow and temperature for trenches/tunnels. As with the conduits described in earlier examples, the heat transfer processes in the air space inside the trench/tunnel are too complex to warrant a complete treatment for design purposes. The thermal resistance of this air space may be approximated by several methods [e.g., by using Equation (9)].

Thermal resistances at the pipe insulation/air interface can also be calculated from heat transfer coefficients as done in the section on Pipes in Air. If the thermal resistance of the air/trench wall interface is also included, use Equation (28):

$$R_{aw} = 1/[2h_t(a+b)] \tag{28}$$

where

R_{aw} = thermal resistance of air/trench wall interface, (m·K)/W

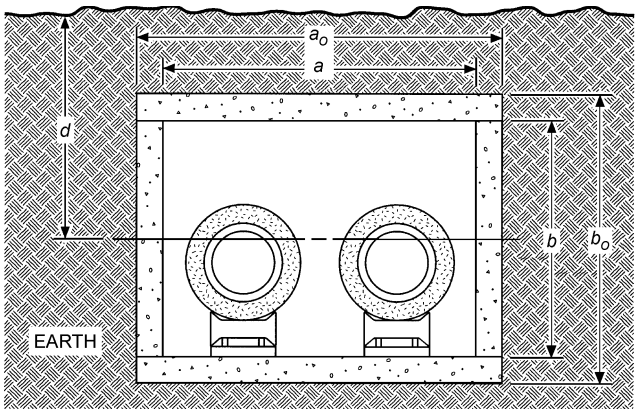


Fig. 12 Pipes in Buried Trenches or Tunnels

h_t = total heat transfer coefficient at air/trench wall interface, W/(m²·K)

The total heat loss from the trench/tunnel is calculated from the following relationship:

$$q = \frac{(t_{p1}-t_s)/R_1 + (t_{p2}-t_s)/R_2}{1+(R_{ss}/R_1)+(R_{ss}/R_2)} \tag{29}$$

where

R_1, R_2 = thermal resistances of two-pipe/insulation systems within trench/tunnel, (m·K)/W
R_{ss} = total thermal resistance on soil side of air within trench/tunnel, (m·K)/W

Once the total heat loss has been found, the air temperature in the trench/tunnel may be found as

$$t_{ta} = t_s + qR_{ss} \tag{30}$$

where t_{ta} is air temperature in the trench/tunnel.

The individual heat flows for the two pipes in the trench/tunnel are then

$$q_1 = (t_{p1} - t_{ta})/R_1 \tag{31}$$

$$q_2 = (t_{p2} - t_{ta})/R_2 \tag{32}$$

If the thermal conductivity of the pipe insulation is a function of temperature, assume an air temperature for the air space before starting calculations. Iterate the calculations if the air temperature calculated with Equation (30) differs significantly from the initial assumption.

Example 10. The walls of a buried trench are 150 mm thick, and the trench is 1 m wide and 0.7 m tall. The trench is constructed of concrete, with a thermal conductivity of k_w = 1.7 W/(m·K). The soil surrounding the trench also has a thermal conductivity of k_s = 1.7 W/(m·K). The centerline of the trench is 1.25 m below grade, and the soil temperature is assumed be 15°C. The trench contains supply and return lines for a medium-temperature water system with the physical and operating parameters identical to those in Example 8.

Solution: Assuming the air temperature within the trench is 40°C, the thermal resistances for the pipe/insulation systems are identical to those in Example 8, or

$$R_1 = 2.62 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

$$R_2 = 2.53 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The thermal resistance of the soil surrounding the trench is given by Equation (27):

$$R_{ts} = \frac{\ln[(3.5\times1.25)/(1^{0.75}\times1.3^{0.25})]}{1.7[1.3/(2\times1)+5.7]} = 0.131 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The trench wall thermal resistance is calculated with Equation (26):

$$R_w = 0.150/[2\times1.7(1+0.7)] = 0.026 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

If the thermal resistance of the air/trench wall is neglected, the total thermal resistance on the soil side of the air space is

$$R_{ss} = R_w + R_{ts} = 0.026 + 0.131 = 0.157 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

Find a first estimate of the total heat loss using Equation (29):

$$q = \frac{(160-15)/2.62 + (100-15)/2.53}{1+(0.157/2.62)+(0.157/2.53)} = 79.3 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The first estimate of the air temperature in the trench is given by Equation (30):

$$t_{ta} = 15 + (79.3\times0.157) = 27.5°\text{C}$$

Refined estimates of the pipe insulation surface temperatures are then calculated using Equations (14) and (15):

$$t_{i1} = 27.5 + [(160-27.5)(0.08/2.62)] = 31.5°\text{C}$$

$$t_{i2} = 27.5 + [(100 - 27.5)(0.09/2.53)] = 30.1°C$$

From these estimates, calculate the revised mean insulation temperatures to find the resultant resistance values. Repeat the calculation procedure until satisfactory agreement between successive estimates of the trench air temperature is obtained. Calculate the individual heat flows from the pipes with Equations (31) and (32).

If the thermal resistance of the trench walls is added to the soil thermal resistance, the thermal resistance on the soil side of the air space is

$$R_{ss} = \frac{\ln[(3.5 \times 1.25)/(0.7^{0.75} \times 1^{0.25})]}{1.7[(1/1.4) + 5.7]} = 0.160 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

The result is less than 2% higher than the resistance previously calculated by treating the trench walls and soil separately. In the event that the soil and trench wall material have significantly different thermal conductivities, this simpler calculation will not yield as favorable results and should not be used.

Pipes in Shallow Trenches

The cover of a shallow trench is exposed to the environment. Thermal calculations for such trenches require the following assumptions: (1) the interior air temperature is uniform as discussed in the section on Pipes in Buried Trenches or Tunnels, and (2) the soil and the trench wall material have the same thermal conductivity. This assumption yields reasonable results if the thermal conductivity of the trench material is used, because most of the heat flows directly through the cover. The thermal resistance of the trench walls and surrounding soil is usually a small portion of the total thermal resistance, and thus the heat losses are not usually highly dependent on this thermal resistance. Using these assumptions, Equations (27) and (29) to (32) may be used for shallow trench systems.

Example 11. Consider a shallow trench having the same physical parameters and operating conditions as the buried trench in Example 10, except that the top of the trench is at grade level. Calculate the thermal resistance of the shallow trench using Equation (27):

$$R_{ts} = R_{ss} = \frac{\ln[(3.5 \times 0.5)/(0.7^{0.75} \times 1^{0.25})]}{1.7[(1/1.4) + 5.7]} = 0.0759 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

Use thermal resistances for the pipe/insulation systems from Example 10, and use Equation (24) to calculate q:

$$q = \frac{(160 - 15)/2.62 + (100 - 15)/2.53}{1 + (0.0759/2.62) + (0.0759/2.53)} = 84.0 \text{ W/m}$$

From this, calculate the first estimate of the air temperature, using Equation (30):

$$t_{ta} = 15 + (84.0 \times 0.0759) = 21.4°C$$

Then refine estimates of the pipe insulation surface temperatures using Equations (14) and (15):

$$t_{i1} = 21.4 + [(160 - 21.4)(0.08/2.62)] = 25.6°C$$

$$t_{i2} = 21.4 + [(100 - 21.4)(0.09/2.53)] = 24.2°C$$

From these, calculate the revised mean insulation temperatures to find resultant resistance values. Repeat the calculation procedure until satisfactory agreement between successive estimates of the trench air temperatures are obtained. If the individual heat flows from the pipes are desired, calculate them using Equations (31) and (32).

Another method for calculating heat losses in a shallow trench assumes an interior air temperature and treats the pipes as pipes in air (see the section on Pipes in Air). Interior air temperatures in the range of 20 to 50°C have been observed in a temperate climate (Phetteplace et al. 1991).

It may be necessary to drain the system or provide heat tracing in areas with significant subfreezing air temperatures in winter, especially for shallow trenches that contain only chilled-water lines (and thus have no source of heat) if the system is not in operation, or is in operation at very low flow rates.

Buried Pipes with Other Geometries

Other geometries not specifically addressed by the previous cases have been used for buried thermal utilities. In some instances, the equations presented previously may be used to approximate the system. For instance, the soil thermal resistance for a buried system with a half-round clay tile on a concrete base could be approximated as a circular system using Equation (6) or (7). In this case, the outer radius r_o is taken as that of a cylinder with the same circumference as the outer perimeter of the clay tile system. The remainder of the resistances and subsequent calculations would be similar to those for a buried trench/tunnel. The accuracy of such calculations varies inversely with the proportion of the total thermal resistance that the thermal resistance in question comprises. In most instances, the thermal resistance of the pipe insulation overshadows other resistances, and the errors induced by approximations in the other resistances are acceptable for design calculations with appropriate conservative assumptions applied.

Pipes in Air

Pipes surrounded by gases may transfer heat via conduction, convection, and/or thermal radiation. Heat transfer modes depend mainly on the surface temperatures and geometry of the system being considered. For air, conduction is usually dominated by the other modes and thus may be neglected. Thermal resistances for cylindrical systems can be found from heat transfer coefficients derived using the following equations. Generally, piping systems used for thermal distribution have sufficiently low surface temperatures to preclude any significant heat transfer by thermal radiation.

Example 12. Consider a 150 mm nominal (168 mm outside diameter), high-temperature hot-water pipe that operates in air at 190°C with 65 mm of mineral wool insulation. The surrounding air annually averages 15°C (288 K). The average annual wind speed is 6 km/h. The insulation is covered with an aluminum jacket with an emittance ε = 0.26. The thickness and thermal resistance of the jacket material are negligible. Because the heat transfer coefficient at the outer surface of the insulation is a function of the temperature there, initial estimates of this temperature must be made. This temperature estimate is also required to estimate mean insulation temperature.

Solution: Assuming that the insulation surface is at 40°C as a first estimate, the mean insulation temperature is calculated as 115°C (313 K). Using the properties of mineral wool given in Example 5, the insulation thermal conductivity is k_i = 0.047 W/(m·K). Using Equation (8), the thermal resistance of the insulation is R_i = 1.94 (m·K)/W. The forced convective heat transfer coefficient at the surface of the insulation can be found using the following equation (ASTM *Standard* C680):

$$h_{cv} = 11.58\left(\frac{1}{d}\right)^{0.2}\left(\frac{2}{t_{oi} + t_a}\right)^{0.181}(t_{oi} - t_a)^{0.266}(1 + 0.7935\,V)^{0.5}$$

$$= 11.58\left(\frac{1}{298}\right)^{0.2}\left(\frac{2}{40 + 15}\right)^{0.181}(40 - 15)^{0.266}(1 + 0.7935 \times 6)^{0.5}$$

$$= 10.4 \text{ W/(m}^2\text{·K)}$$

where

d = outer diameter of surface, mm
t_a = ambient air temperature, °C
V = wind speed, km/h

The radiative heat transfer coefficient must be added to this convective heat transfer coefficient. Determine the radiative heat transfer coefficient as follows (ASTM *Standard* C680):

$$h_{rad} = \varepsilon\sigma\frac{(T_a^4 - T_s^4)}{T_a - T_s}$$

$$h_{rad} = 0.26 \times 5.67 \times 10^{-8} \frac{(313^4 - 288^4)}{313 - 288} = 1.60 \text{ W/(m}^2 \cdot \text{K)}$$

Add the convective and radiative coefficients to obtain a total surface heat transfer coefficient h_t of 12.0 W/(m^2·K). The equivalent thermal resistance of this heat transfer coefficient is calculated from the following equation:

$$R_{surf} = \frac{1}{2\pi r_{oi} h_t} = \frac{1}{2\pi \times 0.149 \times 13.53} = 0.09 \text{ (m·K)/W}$$

With this, the total thermal resistance of the system becomes R_t = 1.94 + 0.09 = 2.03 (m·K)/W, and the first estimate of the heat loss is q = (190 – 15)/2.03 = 86.2 W/m.

An improved estimate of the insulation surface temperature is t_{oi} = 190 – (86.2 × 1.94) = 23°C. From this, a new mean insulation temperature, insulation thermal resistance, and surface resistance can be calculated. The heat loss is then 84.8 W/m, and the insulation surface temperature is calculated as 20°C. These results are close enough to the previous results that further iterations are not warranted.

Note that the contribution of thermal radiation to the heat transfer could have been omitted with negligible effect on the results. In fact, the entire surface resistance could have been neglected and the resulting heat loss would have increased by only about 4%.

In Example 12, the convective heat transfer was forced. In cases with no wind, where the convection is free rather than forced, the radiative heat transfer is more significant, as is the total thermal resistance of the surface. However, in instances where the piping is well insulated, the thermal resistance of the insulation dominates, and minor resistances can often be neglected with little resultant error. By neglecting resistances, a conservative result is obtained (i.e., the heat transfer is overpredicted).

Economical Thickness for Pipe Insulation

A life-cycle cost analysis may be run to determine the economical thickness of pipe insulation. Because the insulation thickness affects other parameters in some systems, each insulation thickness must be considered as a separate system. For example, a conduit system or one with a jacket around the insulation requires a larger conduit or jacket for greater insulation thicknesses. The cost of the extra conduit or jacket material may exceed that of the additional insulation and is therefore usually included in the analysis. It is usually not necessary to include excavation, installation, and backfill costs in the analysis.

A system's life-cycle cost is the sum of the initial capital cost and the present worth of the subsequent cost of heat lost or gained over the life of the system. The initial capital cost needs only to include those costs that are affected by insulation thickness. The following equation can be used to calculate the life-cycle cost:

$$\text{LCC} = \text{CC} + (qt_u C_h \text{PWF}) \quad (33)$$

where

LCC = present worth of life-cycle costs associated with pipe insulation thickness, $/m
CC = capital costs associated with pipe insulation thickness, $/m
q = annual average rate of heat loss, W/m
t_u = utilization time for system each year, s
C_h = cost of heat lost from system, $/J
PWF = present worth factor for future annual heat loss costs, dimensionless

The present worth factor is the reciprocal of the capital recovery factor, which is found from the following equation:

$$\text{CRF} = \frac{i(1+i)^n}{(1+i)^n - 1} \quad (34)$$

where

CRF = cost recovery factor, dimensionless
i = interest rate
n = useful lifetime of system, years

If heat costs are expected to escalate, the present worth factor may be multiplied by an appropriate escalation factor and the result substituted in place of PWF in Equation (33).

Example 13. Consider a steel conduit system with an air space. The insulation is mineral wool with thermal conductivity as given in Examples 5 and 6. The carrier pipe is 100 mm NPS and operates at 175°C for the entire year (8760 h). The conduit is buried 1.2 m to the centerline in soil with a thermal conductivity of 1.7 W/(m·K) and an annual average temperature of 15°C. Neglect the thermal resistance of the conduit and carrier pipe. The useful lifetime of the system is assumed to be 20 years and the interest rate is taken as 10%.

Solution: Find CRF from Equation (34):

$$\text{CRF} = \frac{0.10(1+0.10)^{20}}{(1+0.10)^{20} - 1} = 0.11746$$

The value C_h of heat lost from the system is assumed to be $10 per gigajoule. The following table summarizes the heat loss and cost data for several available insulation thicknesses.

Insulation thickness, mm	40	50	60	70	80	100
Insulation outer radius, mm	97	107	117	127	137	157
Insulation k, W/(m·K)	0.047	0.047	0.047	0.047	0.047	0.047
R_i, Eq. (8), (m·K)/W	1.80	2.13	2.44	2.71	2.97	3.43
R_a, Eq. (9), (m·K)/W	0.097	0.088	0.080	0.074	0.069	0.060
Conduit outer radius, m	0.136	0.136	0.161	0.161	0.178	0.203
R_s, Eq. (7), (m·K)/W	0.27	0.27	0.26	0.26	0.25	0.24
R_t, (m·K)/W	2.17	2.49	2.78	3.04	3.29	3.73
q, heat loss rate, W/m	73.7	64.3	57.6	52.6	48.6	42.9
Conduit system cost, $/m	75.50	80.50	92.50	98.50	108.25	131.25
LCC, Eq. (33), $/m	273.38	253.15	247.16	239.73	238.74	246.44

The table indicates that 80 mm of insulation yields the lowest life-cycle cost for the example. Because the results depend highly on the economic parameters used, they must be accurately determined.

District Geothermal Heat Pump Distribution System Piping Heat Transfer Considerations

As noted previously, recently interest has grown in systems where the distribution medium temperature is near ambient temperature. Heat pumps are normally used within individual buildings to boost near-ambient temperatures to levels suitable for space and domestic hot-water heating. Heat pumps in individual buildings may also be used to generate space cooling. These systems may not have central plants per se but may include geothermal sources/sinks (see Chapter 35 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*). Where distribution systems operate at near-ambient temperatures, insulated piping may not be required, thus greatly simplifying distribution system design and construction. The decision to insulate or not must be guided not only by the prima facia value of heat gains/losses of the distribution piping system, but also by frost protection and impacts of lowered/increased distribution system temperatures to other components of the system (e.g., heat pumps). Some consideration relevant to the decision to insulate or not include the following.

Geothermal heat pump (GHP) systems applied in heating dominated climates/loadings, may frequently circulate a water and antifreeze mixture to allow heat extraction at lower temperatures. In district geothermal heat pump (DGHP) systems, due to extensive lengths of buried piping, circulating fluid volumes may be much higher than those in traditional single-building GHP systems. Additional heat losses from buried uninsulated piping may force higher concentrations of antifreeze in the circulating medium. This not only increases the cost of the circulating medium itself, but also normally comes with pumping power increases. Insulating the extensive buried distribution system DGHP system piping may be more cost effective due to this consideration.

Where DGHP distribution piping operating at subfreezing temperatures is in close proximity to other utility infrastructure, the need to mitigate exposure of other buried utilities to subfreezing temperatures might be dealt with by using insulated piping at that location. Furthermore, when DGHP distribution piping is operating at subfreezing temperatures and frost-susceptible soils are present, insulating the DGHP system piping may be necessary to mitigating frost heaving impacts to not just adjacent buried utilities, but also overlying/adjacent structures such as sidewalks or roadways and adjacent building foundations.

Temperatures above those of undisturbed soils will be experienced in GHP systems during the cooling season, with 40°C being an often-encountered seasonal maximum. This will result in elevated temperatures in surrounding soils that may also have negative impacts on the surrounding soil and surface vegetation. Elevated temperatures in surrounding soil might impact other utilities such as domestic water systems or even buried electrical transmission cables. Insulated piping can offer a solution to such impacts less costly than rerouting of the district geothermal system piping or conflicting utilities.

For DGHP systems relying on ground coupling as a heat source/sink, the minimum/maximum temperatures due to the annual building heating/cooling load cycle will be coincident, or nearly so, with the minimum/maximum soil temperatures at normal burial depths. Unless mitigating steps are taken this co-incidence coupled with the greater distribution (horizontal) buried piping of DGHP systems when compared to single-building GHP, will result in greater seasonal temperature variations than encountered in single building GHP systems. Mitigating measures the designer may take include

- Increasing the amount of vertical ground coupling to offset the heat gains/losses from the horizontal DGHP distribution system piping,
- insulate the horizontal DGHP distribution system piping, and/or
- increasing burial depth of the horizontal DGHP distribution system piping.

A special circumstance of this DGHP thermal design necessity will occur when a DGHP distribution system yet to be fully built out will initially operate with significantly fewer consumers than the built-out design value. Effectively, the pipes will initially be oversized and the heat transfer to/from the surrounding soil will be disproportionally large when compared to the connected building heating/cooling load and thus also the temperature degradation to the circulating fluid. The methods noted above can be used to deal with this situation.

Each of the mitigating measures above will require heat transfer calculations be conducted for the horizontal DGHP distribution system piping. The methods outlined earlier in this chapter should be followed in making these calculations.

3.4 EXPANSION PROVISIONS

All piping expands or contracts because of temperature changes, whether it contains chilled water, steam, or hot water. The piping's length increases or decreases with its temperature. Field conditions and the type of system govern the method used to absorb the movement. Turns where the pipe changes direction must be used to provide flexibility. When the distance between changes in direction becomes too large for the turns to compensate for movement, add expansion loops at appropriate locations (this may require additional right-of-way). If field conditions allow, use the piping's flexibility to allow expansion. Where space constraints do not allow expansion loops and/or changes in direction, mechanical methods, such as expansion joints or ball joints, must be used. However, because ball joints change the direction of a pipe, a third joint may be required to reduce the length between changes in direction.

Chapter 46 covers the design of the pipe bends, loops, and the use of expansion joints. However, the chapter uses conservative stress values. Computer-aided design programs that calculate stress from pressure, thermal expansion, and weight simultaneously allow the designer to meet the requirements of ASME *Standard* B31.1. When larger pipe diameters are required, a computer program should be used to determine whether the pipe will provide the required flexibility. For example, Table 11 in Chapter 46 indicates that a 300 mm standard pipe with 300 mm of movement requires a 4.7 m wide by 9.4 m high expansion loop. One program recommends a 4.0 m wide by 7.9 m high loop; if equal height and width is specified, the loop is 7.2 m in each direction.

Although the inherent flexibility of the piping should be used to handle expansion as much as possible, expansion joints must be used where space is too small to allow a loop to be constructed to handle the required movement. For example, expansion joints are often used in walk-through tunnels and vaults because there is seldom space to construct pipe loops. Either pipe loops or expansion joints can be used for aboveground, concrete shallow trench, direct-buried, and poured-envelope systems. The manufacturer of the conduit or envelope material should design loops and offsets in conduit and poured-envelope systems because clearance and design features are critical to the performance of both the loop and the pipe.

All expansion joints require maintenance, and should therefore always be accessible for service. Joints in direct-buried and poured-envelope systems and trenches without removable covers should be located in access ports.

Cold springing is normally used when thermal expansion compensation is used. In DHC systems with natural flexibility, cold springing minimizes the clearance required for pipe movement only. The pipes are sprung 50% of the total amount of movement, toward the anchor. However, ASME *Standard* B31.1 does not allow cold springing in calculating the stresses in the piping. When expansion joints are used, they are installed in an extended position to achieve maximum movement. Contact the manufacturer of the expansion joint for the proper amount of extension.

In extremely hot climates, anchors may also be required, to compensate for pipe contraction when pipes are installed in high ambient temperatures and then filled with cold water. This can affect buried tees in the piping, especially at branch service line runouts to buildings. Crushable insulation may be used in the trench as part of the backfill, to compensate for the contractions. Anchors should be sized using computer-aided design software.

Pipe Supports, Guides, and Anchors

For premanufactured conduit and poured-envelope systems, the system manufacturer usually designs the pipe supports, guides, and anchors in consultation with the expansion joint manufacturer, if such devices are used. For example, the main anchor force of an in-line axial expansion joint is the sum of the pressure thrust (system pressure times the cross-sectional area of the expansion joint and the joint friction or spring force) and the pipe friction forces. Consult the manufacturer of the expansion device when determining anchor forces. Anchor forces are normally less when expansion is absorbed through the system instead of with expansion joints.

Pipe guides used with expansion joints should be spaced according to the manufacturer's recommendations. They must allow longitudinal or axial motion and restrict motion perpendicular to the axis of the pipe. Guides with graphite or low-friction fluorocarbon slide surfaces are often desirable for long pipe runs (Figure 13). In addition, these surface finishes do not corrode or increase sliding resistance in aboveground installations. Select guides to handle twice the expected movement, so they may be installed in a neutral position without the need for cold-springing the pipe. A computerized stress analysis program can help the designer calculate stresses and moments in the piping system to adequately size any anchors

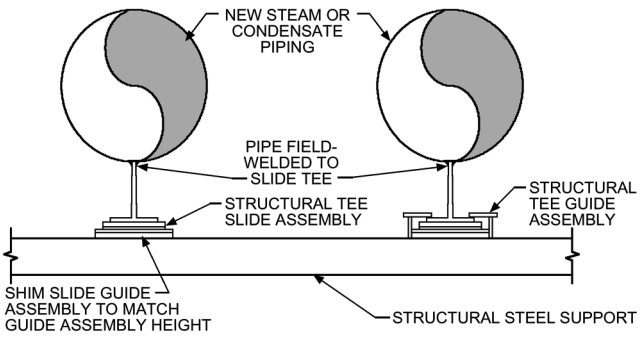


Fig. 13 Slide and Guide Detail

and anchor blocks to ensure compliance with ASME *Standard* B31.1.

3.5 DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM CONSTRUCTION

The combination of aesthetics, first cost, safety, and life-cycle cost naturally divide distribution systems into two distinct categories: aboveground and underground. The materials needed to ensure long life and low heat loss further classify DHC systems into low-, medium-, and high-temperature systems. The temperature range for medium-temperature systems is usually too high for materials used in low-temperature systems; however, the same materials used in high-temperature systems are typically used for medium-temperature systems. Because low-temperature systems have a lower temperature differential between the working fluid temperatures and the environment, heat loss is inherently less. In addition, the options for efficient insulation materials and inexpensive pipe materials that resist corrosion are much greater for low-temperature systems.

The aboveground system has the lowest first cost and the lowest life-cycle cost because it can be maintained easily and constructed with readily available materials. Generally, aboveground systems are acceptable where they are hidden from view or can be hidden by landscaping. Poor aesthetics and the risk of vehicle damage to the aboveground system remove it from contention for many projects.

Although the aboveground system is sometimes partially factory prefabricated, more typically it is entirely field fabricated of components such as pipes, insulation, pipe supports, and insulation jackets or protective enclosures that are commercially available. Other common systems that are completely field fabricated include walk-through tunnels, concrete surface trenches, deep-burial small tunnels, and underground systems that use poured insulation or rigid closed-cell insulation (e.g., cellular glass) to form an envelope around the carrier pipes.

Field-assembled systems must be designed in detail, and all materials must be specified by the project design engineer. Evaluation of the project site conditions indicates which type of system should be considered for the site. For instance, the shallow trench system is best where utilities that are buried deeper than the trench bottom need to be avoided and where the covers can serve as sidewalks. Direct-buried conduit, with a thicker steel casing coated in either epoxy or HDPE or wrapped in fiberglass-reinforced polymer/plastic (FRP), may be the only system that can be used in flooded sites where the conduit is in direct contact with groundwater. The conduit system is used where aesthetics is important. It is often used for short distances between buildings and the main distribution system, and where the owner is willing to accept higher life-cycle costs.

Direct-buried conduit, concrete surface trench, and other underground systems must be routed to avoid existing utilities, which requires a detailed site survey and considerable design effort. Exterior surface temperature of the conduit is an important issue that must be addressed when selecting the appropriate construction materials and components that compose the conduit; temperature may be calculated using the methods previously outlined. In the absence of a detailed soil temperature distribution study, direct-buried heating systems should be spaced more than 4.5 m from other utilities constructed of plastic pipes because the temperature of the soil during dry conditions may be high enough to reduce the strength of plastic pipe to an unacceptable level. The strength of PVC at 60°C, for example, is only 20% of its room-temperature value. Rigid, extruded polystyrene insulation board may be used to insulate adjacent utilities from the impact of a buried heat distribution pipe; however, the temperature limit of the extruded polystyrene insulation must not be exceeded. Numerical analysis of the thermal problem may be required to ensure that the desired effect is achieved. Waterproofing the concrete trench or tunnel depends on the groundwater level. There are many methods of waterproofing belowground concrete structures, including membranes and concrete additives. Carefully address these issues so that the concrete structure outlives the piping system.

Tunnels that provide walk-through or crawl-through access can be buried in nearly any location without causing future problems because utilities are typically placed in the tunnel. Regardless of the type of construction, it is usually cost effective to route distribution piping through the basements of buildings, but only after addressing liability issues. In laying out the main supply and return piping, consider redundancy of supply and return. If a looped system is used to provide redundancy, flow rates under all possible failure modes must be addressed when sizing and laying out the piping.

Access ports for underground systems should be at critical points, such as where there are

- High or low points on the system profile that vent trapped air or where the system can be drained
- Elevation changes in the distribution system that are needed to maintain the required constant slope
- Major branches with isolation valves
- Steam traps and condensate drainage points on steam lines
- Mechanical expansion devices

To facilitate leak location and repair and to limit damage caused by leaks, access points generally should be spaced no farther than 150 m apart. Pay special attention to the safety of personnel who come in contact with distribution systems or who must enter spaces occupied by underground systems. The regulatory authority's definition of a confined space and the possibility of exposure to high-temperature or high-pressure piping can significantly affect the access design, which must be addressed by the designer. Gravity venting of tunnels is good practice, and access ports and tunnels should have lighting and convenience outlets to aid in inspection and maintenance of anchors, expansion joints, and piping.

Piping Materials and Standards

Supply Pipes for Steam and Hot Water. Adequate temperature and pressure ratings for the intended service should be specified for any piping. All piping, fittings, and accessories should be in accordance with ASME *Standard* B31.1 or with local requirements if more stringent. For steam and hot water, all joints should be welded and pipe should conform to either ASTM *Standard* A53 seamless or ERW, Grade B; or ASTM *Standard* A106 seamless, Grade B. Do not use ASTM *Standard* A53, Type F, because of its lower allowable stress and because of how its seams are manufactured. Mechanical joints of any type are not recommended for steam or hot water. Pipe wall thickness is determined by the maximum operating temperature and pressure. In the United States, most piping for steam and hot water is Schedule 40 for 250 mm NPS and below and standard for 300 mm NPS and above.

Many European low-temperature water systems have piping with a wall thickness similar to Schedule 10. The reduced piping material in these systems means they are not only less expensive,

but they also develop reduced expansion forces and thus require simpler methods of expansion compensation, a point to consider when choosing between a high- and low-temperature system. Welding pipes with thinner walls requires extra care and may require additional inspection. Also, extra care is required to avoid internal and external corrosion because the thinner wall provides a much lower corrosion allowance.

Condensate Return Pipes. Condensate pipes require special consideration because condensate is much more corrosive than steam. This corrosiveness is caused by the oxygen that the condensate accumulates. The usual method used to compensate for condensate corrosiveness is to select steel pipe that is thicker than the steam pipe. For highly corrosive condensate, stainless steel and/or other corrosion-resistant materials should be considered. Materials that are corrosion resistant in air may not be corrosion resistant when exposed to condensate; therefore, a material with good experience handling condensate should be selected. FRP or glass-reinforced plastic (GRP) pipe used for condensate return has not performed well and should be avoided. Failed steam traps, pipe resin solubility, deterioration at elevated temperatures, and thermal expansion are thought to be the causes of the premature failures seen.

Chilled-Water Distribution. For chilled-water systems, a variety of pipe materials, such as steel, ductile iron, reinforced concrete, HDPE, PVC, and FRP/GRP, have been used successfully. If ductile iron or steel is used, the designer must resolve the internal and external corrosion issue, which may be significant unless cement-lined ductile iron is used. Soil temperature is usually highest when chilled-water loads are highest; therefore, it is usually life-cycle cost-effective to insulate the chilled-water pipe. Phetteplace et al. (2019) has more information on thermal design of chilled-water distribution systems, including the effects of surface type (e.g., pavement, grass). Life-cycle cost analysis often favors a factory-prefabricated product insulated with sprayed or injected foam with a waterproof casing or a field-fabricated system insulated with rigid closed-cell insulation. If a nonmetallic product is selected, be careful to maintain an adequate distance from any high-temperature underground system that may be near. Damage to the chilled-water system would most likely occur from elevated soil temperatures when the chilled-water circulation stopped. Proper pressure relief devices should be designed into all systems to compensate for the increase in system pressure caused by increases in fluid temperatures.

Uninsulated chilled-water piping placement should take into account the proximity of any heating piping, especially pipes that are poorly insulated and old. Consider increasing the distance between these piping systems, especially for nonmetallic piping. The heating distribution system should be at least 4.5 m from a chilled-water system containing plastic unless a detailed study of the soil temperature distribution indicates otherwise. Rigid extruded polystyrene insulation board may be used to insulate adjacent chilled-water lines from the effects of a buried heat distribution pipe; however, care must be taken not to exceed the temperature limits of the extruded polystyrene insulation; numerical analysis of the thermal problem may be required. Finally, at valve locations or when transitioning from ductile or plastic piping to steel at the buildings, flanged connections are usually best, but should be located inside the building or a small access port and not directly buried. Experience shows that buried flanges, or flanged connections such as to valves, are prone to leakage, are a weak link in the piping system, and should be avoided. Proper gasket selection and bolt torque are also critical to a leak-free system.

Table 12 summarizes some of the important aspects of the various piping materials, and Figure 14 shows approximate relative costs of the most popular materials. The major advantages and disadvantages of each of these materials, as well as applicable standards when used for the carrier pipe, are as follows:

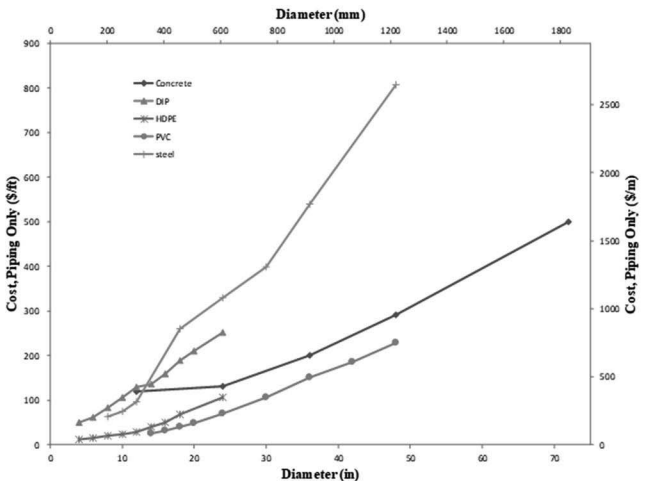


Fig. 14 Relative Costs for Piping Alone, Uninsulated

Includes joining, but does not include design, supervision and inspection, fittings, excavation, backfill, or surface restoration.

Cost data are from RSMeans-CostWorks® (www.rsmeansonline.com) for first-quarter 2018 water utilities.

- **Steel**

  Advantages: High strength and good flexibility, can be joined by welding for a high-integrity joint that can be inspected for quality control, widely available in all sizes, familiar material to most workforces.

  Disadvantages: Relatively high cost, highly susceptible to corrosion and will require corrosion protection. Skilled labor force required for welding. Slower installation, especially in larger diameters.

  Standards: ASTM A53/A53M, ASTM A106A/106M.

- **Copper**

  Advantages: Good flexibility, can be joined by soldering for a high-integrity joint, corrosion resistant but may still require protection, familiar material to most workforces.

  Disadvantages: Expensive, only available/practical in small diameters (approximately 150 mm and smaller).

  Standards: ASTM B88.

- **Ductile Iron**

  Advantages: Reasonable strength and flexibility, available in sizes from 100 mm to about 1.6 m, familiar material to many workforces. Faster installation.

  Disadvantages: Heavy, susceptible to corrosion and requires corrosion protection, can only be joined by mechanical joints, some mechanical joint designs require thrust blocks at all changes in direction. Fittings are expensive. Allowable leakage per standards.

  Standards: AWWA C151.

- **Cementitious Pipe**

  Advantages: Reasonable strength, available in all sizes, familiar material to many workforces.

  Disadvantages: Heavy, poor flexibility, can only be joined by mechanical joints, thrust blocks are required, difficult to add branch line piping to. Lower pressure and velocity limits. Allowable leakage per standards.

Table 12 Relative Merits of Piping Materials Commonly Used for District Cooling Distribution Systems

Piping System	Carrier Pipe Joint Integrity	Joint Inspection	Insulated Joints Possible*	Corrosion Resistance	Installation Skill Level	Installation Time	Strength under Burial Conditions	Relative Installed Cost
Welded steel	Excellent	NDT (x-ray, etc.), pressure testing	Yes	Low, requires protection	High	High	Excellent	High
Soldered copper	Medium	Pressure testing	Yes	Good	Medium	Medium	Good	Small D = High
Ductile iron	Low	Pressure testing	No	Low, requires protection	Low/medium	Low	Very good	Low/medium
Cement pipe	Low	Pressure testing	No	Excellent	Low/medium	Low	Good	Low/medium
FRP	Low/medium	Pressure testing	Yes	Excellent	Medium	Low/medium	Low	Low/medium
PVC	Low	Pressure testing	No	Excellent	Low/medium	Low	Low	Low
HDPE	High	Pressure testing	Yes	Excellent	Medium	Small D = Low		
Large D = Medium	Excellent	Small D = Low						
Large D = Medium/high								

*Insulated joints are not recommended for piping systems that have allowable leakage rates for joints.

Standards: AWWA C300, AWWA C301, AWWA C302, AWWA C303.

- **FRP**

  Advantages: Low mass and high strength, available in all sizes.

  Disadvantages: Poor flexibility, can only be joined by cement/field layup or mechanical joints, difficult to add branch line piping to, cemented joints must be kept clean and dry and may be slow to cure at low ambient temperatures, unfamiliar material to many workforces. Point of leakage may not be obvious.

  Standards: AWWA C950, ASTM D2996 e1.

- **PVC**

  Advantages: Low mass, low cost, available in sizes up to 1.2 m.

  Disadvantages: Low strength and poor flexibility, loses strength very quickly at elevated temperatures and becomes brittle at low temperatures, can only be joined by cement or mechanical joints, cemented joints must be kept clean and dry, difficult to add branch line piping to. Water hammer will fracture piping. Requires thrust blocks and has lower velocity limits.

  Standards: AWWA C900, AWWA C905, ASTM D1785, ASTM D2241.

- **PE and HDPE**

  Advantages: Low mass, very flexible, can be fusion welded for high-integrity joints, available in sizes up to 1.6 m. Leak free and fully restrained (no anchor blocks).

  Disadvantages: Low strength compared to steel and FRP results in significant wall thickness and thus cost in larger diameters.

  Increased wall thickness also reduces inside diameter, which results in higher pressure losses and may require larger sizes for the same flow rates. Larger-diameter fusion welding machines may be of limited availability. Cost fluctuates with petroleum pricing.

  Standards: AWWA C901, AWWA C906.

Aboveground Systems

An aboveground system consists of a distribution pipe, insulation that surrounds the pipe, and a protective jacket that surrounds the insulation. In outdoor applications, the protective jacket should be metal with an 0.08 mm thick polysurlyn moisture barrier heat-laminated to the inside surface. Note that this moisture barrier is used to reduce the likelihood of corrosion on the interior surface of the jacket, is not the same as a vapor retarder, and does not replace a vapor retarder on cold systems. When the distribution system carries chilled water or other cold media, a vapor retarder is required for all types of insulation except cellular glass. In an ASHRAE test by Chyu et al. (1998a), cellular glass absorbed essentially zero water in a chilled-water application. In heating applications, the vapor retarder is not needed nor recommended; however, a reasonably watertight jacket is required to keep stormwater out of the insulation. The jacket material can be aluminum, stainless steel, galvanized steel, other metals, plastic sheet, a multilayered fabric and organic cement composite, or a combination of these. In outdoor applications, only metal or ultraviolet-resistant fabric and organic cement composites should be used.

Structural columns and supports are typically made of wood, steel, or concrete. A crossbar is often placed across the top of the column when more than one distribution pipe is supported from one column. Sidewalk and road crossings require an elaborate support structure to elevate the distribution piping above traffic. Pipe expansion and contraction is taken up in loops, elbows, and bends. Manufactured expansion joints may be used, but they are usually not recommended because of a shorter life or a higher frequency of required maintenance than the remainder of the system. Supports that attach the distribution pipes to the support columns are commercially available as described in MSS *Standards* SP-58 and SP-69. The distribution pipes should have welded joints.

An aboveground system has the lowest first cost and is the easiest to inspect and maintain; therefore, it has the lowest life-cycle cost. It is the standard against which all other systems are compared. Its major drawbacks are its poor aesthetics, its safety hazard if struck by vehicles and equipment, and its susceptibility to freezing in cold climates if circulation is stopped or if heat is not added to the working medium. These drawbacks often remove this system from contention as a viable alternative.

Underground Systems

An underground system solves the problems of aesthetics and exposure to vehicles of the aboveground system; however, burying a system causes other problems with materials, design, construction, and maintenance that have historically been difficult to solve. An underground heat distribution system is not a typical utility like gas, domestic water, and sanitary systems, and requires an order of magnitude more design effort and construction inspection accuracy when compared to other utility distribution projects. The thermal effects and difficulty of keeping the insulation dry make it much more difficult to design and construct when compared to systems operating near the ambient temperature. Underground systems cost almost 10 times as much to build, and require much more to operate and maintain. Heat distribution systems must be designed for zero leakage and must account for thermal expansion, degradation of material as a function of temperature, high- pressure and transient shock waves, heat loss restrictions, and accelerated corrosion. In the past, resolv-

ing one problem in underground systems often created a new, more serious problem that was not recognized until premature failure occurred. Segan and Chen (1984) describe the types of premature failures that may occur if this guidance is ignored.

Common types of underground systems are the walk-through tunnel, concrete surface trench, deep-buried small tunnel, poured insulation envelope, rigid closed-cell insulation, and conduit system.

Walk-Through Tunnel. This system (Figure 15) consists of a field-erected tunnel large enough for a person to walk through after the distribution pipes are in place. It is essentially an aboveground system enclosed with a tunnel. The tunnel is buried deep enough to cover the top with earth, and is large enough for routine maintenance and inspection to be done easily without excavation. The preferred construction material for the tunnel walls and top cover is reinforced concrete. Masonry units and metal preformed sections have been used to construct the tunnel and top with less success, because of groundwater leakage and metal corrosion. The distribution pipes are supported from the tunnel wall or floor with pipe supports that are commonly used on aboveground systems or in buildings. Some groundwater will penetrate the top and walls of the tunnel; therefore, a water drainage system must be provided. Usually, electric lights and electric service outlets are provided for ease of inspection and maintenance. This system has the highest first cost of all underground systems; however, it can have the lowest life-cycle cost because of its ease of maintenance, the ability to correct construction errors easily, and an extremely long life. If steam or HTHW piping is located in the tunnel, ambient temperatures may become extreme; such tunnels are typically either forced ventilated or gravity ventilated. Additional insulation may be required for chilled-water piping that shares the tunnel with steam or HTHW piping, because of the higher ambient temperatures. Selected pipe insulation material should be coupled with a high-performance vapor retarder and possibly a protective jacket.

Shallow Concrete Surface Trench. This system (Figure 16) is a partially buried system. The floor is usually about 1 m below the surface grade. It is only wide enough for the carrier pipes and the pipe insulation plus some additional width to allow for pipe movement and possibly enough room for a person to stand on the floor. The trench usually is about as wide as it is deep. The top is constructed of reinforced concrete covers that protrude slightly above the surface and may also serve as a sidewalk. The floor and walls are usually cast-in-place reinforced concrete and the top is either precast or cast-in-place concrete. Precast concrete floor and wall sections have not been successful because of the large number of oblique joints and nonstandard sections required to follow the surface topography and to slope the floor for drainage. This system is designed to handle stormwater and groundwater that enters the system, so the floor is always sloped toward a drainage point, which typically is a steam trap pit, valve vault, or access port where a sump pump or other positive-drainage method is provided.

Cross beams that attach to the side walls are preferred to support the carrier pipes. This keeps the floor free of obstacles that would interfere with drainage and allows the distribution pipes to be assembled before lowering them on the pipe supports. Also, floor-mounted pipe supports tend to corrode.

The carrier pipes, pipe supports, expansion loops and bends, and insulation jacket are similar to aboveground systems, with the exception of pipe insulation. Experience with these systems indicates that flooding will occur several times during their design life; therefore, the insulation must be able to survive flooding and boiling and then return to near its original thermal efficiency. The pipe insulation is covered with a metal or plastic jacket to protect the insulation from abuse and from stormwater that enters at the top cover butt joints. Small inspection ports of about 300 mm diameter may be cast into the top covers at key locations so the system can be inspected without removing the top covers. All replaceable elements, such as valves, condensate pumps, steam traps, strainers, sump pumps, and meters, are located in valve vaults. The first cost of this system is among the lowest for underground systems because it uses typical construction techniques and materials. The life-cycle cost is often the lowest because it is easy to maintain, correct construction deficiencies, and repair leaks.

Deep-Bury Tunnel. The tunnel in this system (Figure 17) is only large enough to contain the distribution piping, pipe insulation, and pipe supports. One type of deep-bury tunnel is the shallow concrete surface trench covered with earth and sloped independent of the topography. Because the system is covered with earth, it is essentially not maintainable between valve vaults without major excava-

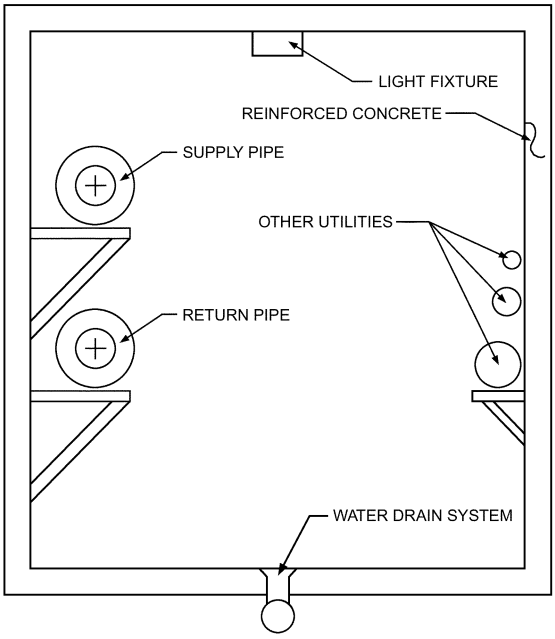


Fig. 15 Walk-Through Tunnel

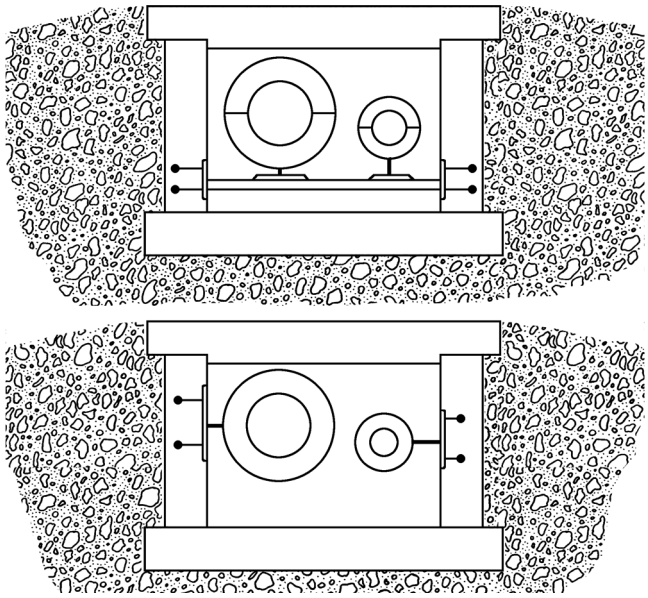


Fig. 16 Concrete Surface Trench

tion. All details of this system must be designed and all materials must be specified by the project design engineer.

Because this system is not maintainable between valve vaults, great care must be taken to select materials that will last for the intended life and to ensure that the groundwater drainage system will function reliably. This system is intended to be used on sites where the groundwater elevation is typically lower than the bottom of the tunnel. The system can tolerate some groundwater saturation, depending on the watertightness of the construction and the capacity and reliability of the internal drainage. But even in desert areas, storms occur that expose underground systems to flooding; therefore, as with other types of underground systems, it must be designed to handle groundwater or stormwater that enters the system. The distribution pipe insulation must be of the type that can withstand flooding and boiling and still retain its thermal efficiency.

Construction of this system is typically started in an excavated trench by pouring a cast-in-place concrete base that is sloped so intruding groundwater can drain to the valve vaults. The slope selected must also be compatible with the pipe slope requirements of the distribution system. The concrete base may have provisions for the supports for the distribution pipes, the groundwater drainage system, and the mating surface for the side walls. The side walls may have provisions for the pipe supports if the pipes are not bottom supported. If the upper portion is to have cast-in-place concrete walls, the bottom may have reinforcing steel for the walls protruding upward. The pipe supports, distribution pipes, and pipe insulation are all installed before the top cover is installed.

The groundwater drainage system may be a trough formed into the concrete bottom, a sanitary drainage pipe cast into the concrete bottom, or a sanitary pipe that is located slightly below the concrete base. The cover for the system is typically either of cast-in-place concrete or preformed sections such as precast concrete sections or half-round clay tile sections. The top covers must mate to the bottom and each other as tightly as possible to limit entry of groundwater. After the covers are installed, the system is covered with earth to match the existing topography.

Poured Insulation. This system (Figure 18) is buried with the distribution system pipes encased in an envelope of insulating material and the insulation envelope covered with a thick layer of earth as required to match existing topography. This system is used on sites where the groundwater is typically well below the piping system. Like other underground systems, experience indicates that it will be flooded because the soil will become saturated with water several times during the design life; therefore, the design must accommodate flooding.

The insulation material serves several functions. It may support the distribution pipes as bedding and backfill, with additional support as recommended by the product manufacturer, and it must support earth loads. The insulation must prevent groundwater from entering the interior of the envelope, and it must have long-term resistance to physical breakdown caused by heat and water. The insulation envelope must allow the distribution pipes to expand and contract axially as the pipes change temperature. In elbows, expansion loops, and bends, the insulation must allow formed cavities for lateral movement of the pipes, or be able to migrate around the pipe without significant distortion of the insulation envelope while still retaining the required structural load-carrying capacity. Pay special attention to corrosion of metal parts and water penetration at anchors and structural supports that penetrate the insulation envelope.

Hot distribution pipes tend to drive moisture out of the insulation as steam; however, pipes used to distribute a cooling medium tend to condense water in the insulation, which reduces the insulation's thermal resistance. A groundwater drainage system may be required, depending on the insulation material selected and severity of the groundwater; however, if such drainage is needed, it is a strong indicator that this is not the proper system for the site conditions.

This system is constructed by excavating a trench with a bottom slope that matches the desired slope of the distribution piping. The width of the bottom of the trench is usually the same as the width of the insulation envelope because it serves as a form. The distribution piping is then assembled in the trench and supported at the anchors and by blocks that are removed as the insulation is poured in place. The form for the insulation can be the trench bottom and sides, wooden forms, or sheets of plastic, depending on the type of insulation used and the site conditions. The insulation envelope is covered with earth to complete the installation.

The project design engineer is responsible for finding an insulation material that fulfills all of the previously mentioned requirements. At present, no standards have been developed for insulation used in this type of application. **Hydrophobic powders**, which are a special type of pulverized rock treated to be water repellent, have been used successfully. The hydrophobic characteristic of this powder prevents water from dampening the powder and has some ability as a barrier for preventing water from entering the insulation envelope. This insulating powder typically has a much higher thermal conductivity than mineral wool or fiberglass pipe insulation; therefore, the thickness of the poured envelope must be significantly greater. In addition, Phetteplace et al. (1998) found installed heat losses to be much higher than would be expected using manu-

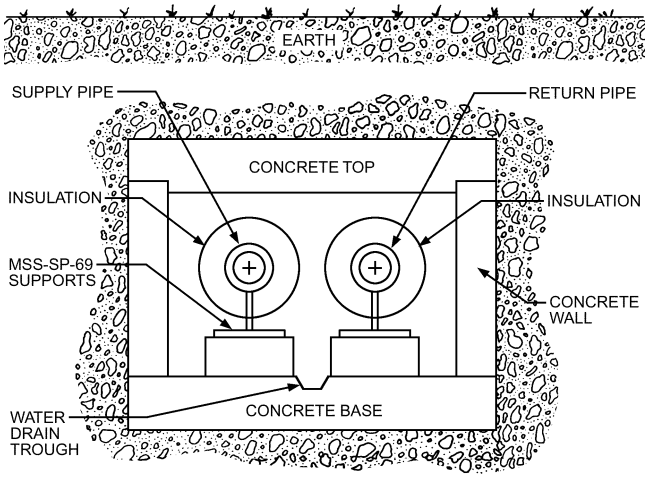


Fig. 17 Deep-Bury Small Tunnel (Boxed Conduit)

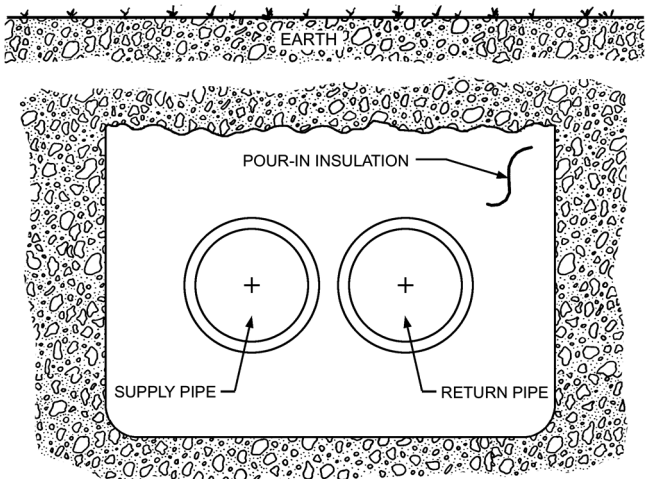


Fig. 18 Poured Insulation System

facturer's data for one poured insulation material, and that actual installed dimensions were less than manufacturer's recommendations in the majority of installations. This may have been the result of the design or construction errors, contractors purposely "shorting" on dimensions, or compaction during or after backfilling. The user is cautioned to verify dimensions during construction and also use appropriate in-place densities for the poured insulation material; do not use bulk or loose density. Measure installed density by a meaningful test for noncohesive soils (e.g., ASTM *Standard* D4253). Furthermore, thermal conductivity is a strong function of density and thus must also be measured at realistic in-place densities. As with any system, the designer should analyze the cost of the alternatives, including preinsulated (i.e., conduit) or field-insulated piping.

Field-Installed, Direct-Buried Rigid Closed-Cell Insulation. In this system (Figure 19), a rigid closed-cell insulation is covered with an asphaltic jacket. The insulation supports the pipe. Oversized loops with internal support elements provide for expansion. The project design engineer must make provisions for pipe movement in the expansion loops. As shown in Figure 18, a drain should be installed to drain groundwater away. A waterproof jacket is recommended for all buried applications.

When used for heating applications, the dry soil condition must be investigated to determine if the temperature of the jacket exceeds the material's allowable temperature (see the section on Methods of Heat Transfer Analysis). This is one of the controlling conditions to determine how high the carrier pipe fluid temperature can be without exceeding the temperature limits of the jacket material. Insulation thickness depends on the thermal operating parameters of the carrier pipe. For maximum system integrity under extreme operating conditions, such as groundwater flooding, the jacketing may be applied to the insulation segments in the fabrication shop with hot asphalt. As with other underground systems, experience indicates that this system may be flooded several times during its projected life.

Conduits

The term conduit denotes an entire assembly, which consists of a carrier pipe, the pipe insulation, the casing, and the exterior casing coating (Figure 20). The conduit is assembled in a factory and shipped as unit called a **conduit section**. The pipe that carries the working medium is called a **carrier pipe** and the outermost perimeter enclosure is called a **casing**.

Each conduit section is shipped in lengths up to 12.2 m. Elbows, tees, loops, and bends are factory prefabricated to match the straight sections. The prefabricated components are assembled at the construction site; therefore, a construction contract is typically required for trenching, backfilling, connecting to buildings, connecting to distribution systems, constructing valve vaults, and performing some electrical work associated with sump pumps, power receptacles, and lights.

Much of the design work is done by the factory that manufactures the prefabricated sections; however, the field work must be designed and specified by the project design engineer or architect. Prefabricated components create a serious problem with accountability. For comparison, when systems are entirely field assembled, the design responsibility clearly belongs to the project design engineer, and system assembly and installation are clearly the responsibility of the construction contractor. When a condition arises where a conduit system cannot be built without modifying prefabricated components, or if the construction contractor does not follow the instructions from the prefabricator, a serious conflict of responsibility arises. The design engineer, as the engineer of record (EOR), assumes the responsibility of review and approval of any design work by others. For these reasons, it is imperative that the project design engineer or architect clearly delineate the responsibilities of the factory prefabricator.

Crushing loads have been used (erroneously) to size the casing thickness, assuming that corrosion was not a factor. However, corrosion rate is usually the controlling factor because the casing temperature can range from less than 40°C to more than 150°C, a

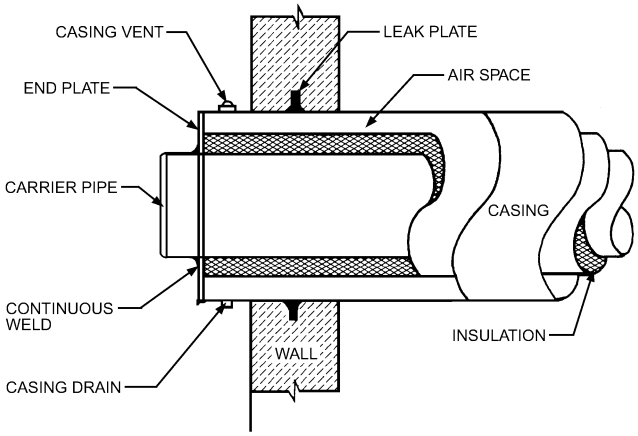


Fig. 20 Conduit System Components

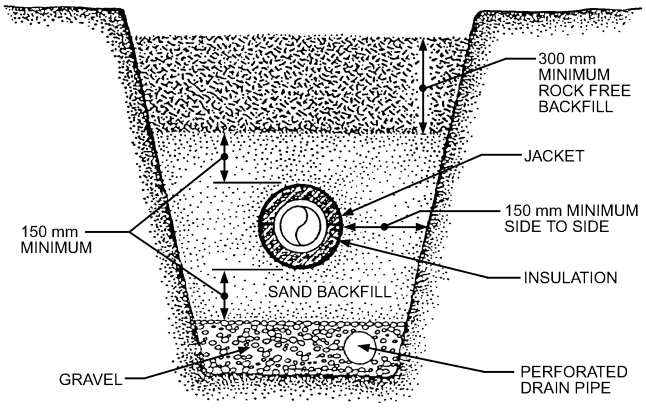


Fig. 19 Field-Installed, Direct-Buried Rigid Closed-Cell Insulation System

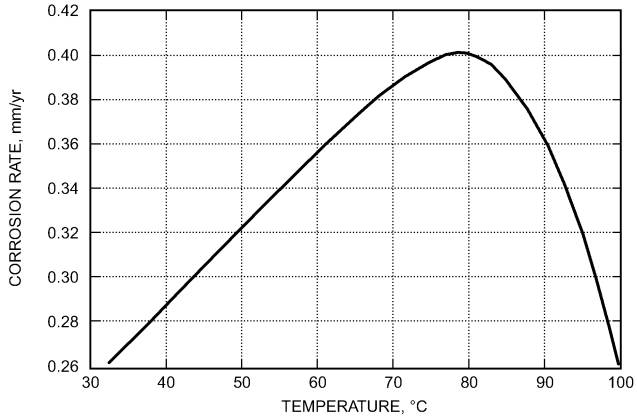


Fig. 21 Corrosion Rate in Aggressive Environment Similar to Mild Steel Casings in Soil

range that encompasses the maximum corrosion rate of steel (Figure 21). As shown in the figure, the steel casing of a district heating pipe experiences corrosion rates several times that of domestic water pipes. The casing temperature varies with burial depth, soil conditions, carrier pipe temperature, and pipe insulation thickness. The casing must be strong and thick enough to withstand expansion and contraction forces and corrosion degradation.

All insulation must be kept dry for it to maintain its thermal insulating properties; the exception is cellular glass in cold applications. Because underground systems may be flooded several times during their design life, even on sites that are thought to be dry, a reliable water intrusion removal system is necessary in the valve vaults. Two designs are used to ensure that the insulation performs satisfactorily for the life of the system. In the **air space system**, an annular air space between the pipe insulation and the casing allows the insulation to be dried out if water enters. In the **water spread limiting (WSL) system**, which has no air space, the conduit is designed to keep water from entering the insulation. If water enters one section, a WSL system slows or prevents its spread to adjacent sections of piping.

The air space conduit system (Figures 22 and 23) should have an insulation that can survive short-term flooding without damage. The conduit manufacturer usually runs a boiling test with the insulation installed in the typical factory casing. No U.S. standard has been approved for this boiling test; however, the U.S. government uses a Federal Agency Committee 96 h boiling test for conduit insulation [see Phetteplace et al. (2013b) for protocol]. The insulation must have demonstrated that it can be dried with air flowing through an annular air space, and it must retain nearly new thermal insulating properties when dried.

Insulation fails because the bonding agents, called binders, that hold the principal insulation material in the desired shape degrade. The annular air space around the insulation, typically more than 25 mm wide, allows air to flow outside the insulation to dry it. Unfortunately, the air space has a serious detrimental side effect: it allows unwanted water to flow freely to other parts of the system.

The WSL system (Figure 24) encloses the insulation in an envelope that will not allow water to contact the insulation. The typical insulation is polyurethane foam, which will be ruined if excess water infiltration occurs. Polyurethane foam is limited to a temperature of about 120°C for a service life of 30 years or more. Europe has the most successful of the WSL systems, which are typically used in low-temperature water applications. These systems, available in the United States as well, meet CEN European *Standard* EN 253 with regard to all major construction details. Standards also have been established for fittings (EN 448), preinsulated valves (EN 488), field joint assemblies (EN 489), and system design (EN 13941). With this system, the carrier pipe, insulation, and casing are bonded together to form a single unit. Forces caused by thermal expansion are passed as shear forces to the mating component and ultimately to the soil; thus, no additional expansion provisions are required. Movement at changes in direction (elbows) may be accommodated for by cushions.

This type of WSL system is feasible because of the small temperature differential and because the thinner carrier pipe wall creates smaller expansion forces because of its low cross-sectional area. Some systems rely on a watertight field joint between joining casing sections to extend the envelope to a distant envelope termination point where the casing is sealed to the carrier pipe. Other systems form the waterproof insulation envelope in each individual prefabricated conduit section, using the casing and carrier pipe to form part of the envelope and a waterproof bulkhead to seal the casing to the carrier pipe. In another type of construction, a second pipe fits tightly over the carrier pipe and seals the insulation between the second pipe and casing to achieve a watertight insulation envelope.

Conduit Design Conditions. The following three design conditions must be addressed to have reasonable assurance that the system selected will have a satisfactory service life:

- **Maximum heat loss** occurs when the soil is wettest and the conduit is shallowly buried (minimum burial depth), usually with

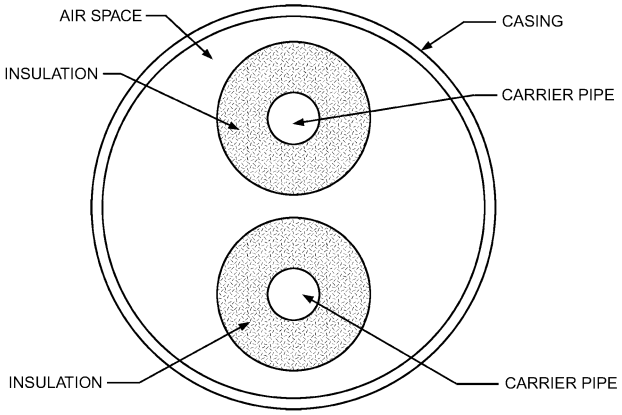


Fig. 23 Conduit System with Two Carrier Pipes and Annular Air Space

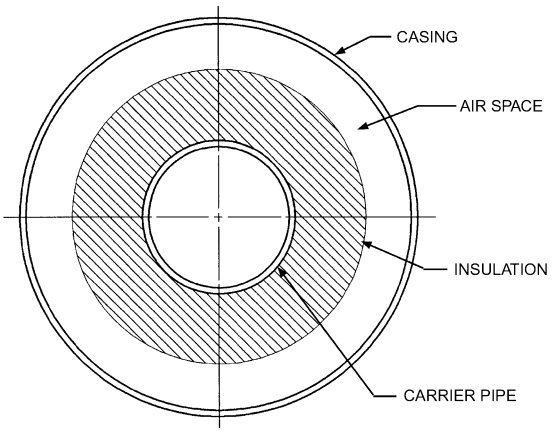


Fig. 22 Conduit System with Annular Air Space and Single Carrier Pipe

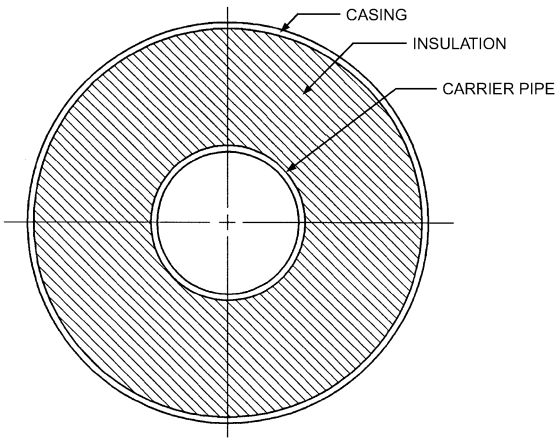
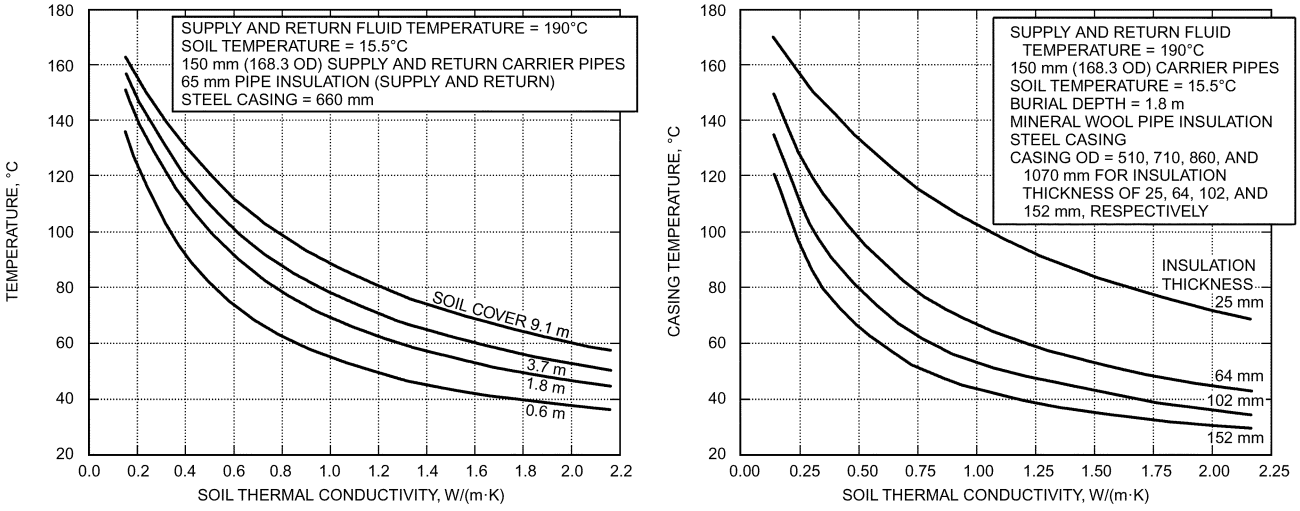


Fig. 24 Conduit System with Single Carrier Pipe and No Air Space (WSL)



A. EFFECT OF BURIAL DEPTH ON CASING TEMPERATURE

B. EFFECT OF INSULATION THICKNESS ON CASING TEMPERATURE

Fig. 25 Conduit Casing Temperature Versus Soil Thermal Conductivity

about 0.6 m of earth cover. This condition represents the highest gross heat transfer and is used to size the distribution piping and equipment in the central heating plant. For heating piping, because the casing is coldest during start-up, the relative movement of the carrier pipe with respect to the casing may be maximum during this condition.

- A **dry-soil condition** may occur when the conduit is buried deep. The soil plays a more significant role in the heat transfer than the pipe insulation because of the soil's thickness (and thus, insulating value). The highest temperature of the insulation, casing, and casing coating occur during this condition. Paradoxically, the minimum heat loss occurs during this condition because the soil acts as a good insulator. This condition is used to select temperature-sensitive materials and to design for casing expansion. The relative movement of the carrier pipe with respect to the casing may be at minimum during this condition; however, if the casing is not restrained, its movement with respect to the soil will be at maximum. If restrained, the casing axial stresses and axial forces will be highest and the casing allowable stresses will be lowest because of the high casing temperature. Buckling of the casing is possible in extreme situations.

Figure 25A shows the effect of burial depth on casing temperature as a function of soil thermal conductivity for a typical system. Figure 25B shows the effect of insulation thickness on casing temperature, again as a function of soil thermal conductivity. Analysis of Figure 25A and 25B suggests some design solutions that could lower the effects of the dry-soil condition: reducing carrier pipe temperature, using thicker carrier pipe insulation, providing a device to keep the soil wet, or minimizing burial depth. However, if these solutions are not feasible or cost effective, a different type of material or an alternative system should be considered.

Although it is possible that the soil will never dry out, given the variability of climate in most areas, it is likely that a drought will occur during the life of the system. Only one very dry condition can cause permanent damage to the insulation or other system components if the soil thermal conductivity drops below the assumed design value. On-site measurement of the driest soil condition likely to cause insulation damage is not feasible. As a result, the designer is left with the conservative choice of using the lowest thermal conductivity from Table 9 to calculate the highest temperature to be used to select materials.

- The **nominal** or **average condition** occurs when the soil is at its average water content and the conduit is buried at the average depth. This condition is used to compute the yearly energy consumption from heat loss to the soil (see Table 9 for soil thermal conductivity and the previous section on Thermal Properties).

Cathodic Protection of Direct-Buried Conduits

Corrosion is an electrochemical process that occurs when a corrosion cell is formed. A corrosion cell consists of an anode, a cathode, a connecting path between them, and an electrolyte (soil or water). The structure of this cell is the same as a dry-cell battery, and, like a battery, it produces a direct electrical current. The anode and cathode in the cell may be dissimilar metals, and because of differences in their natural electrical potentials, a current flows from anode to cathode. When current leaves an anode, it destroys the anode material at that point. The anode and cathode may also be the same material. Differences in composition, environment, temperature, stress, or shape makes one section anodic and an adjacent section cathodic. With a connection path and the presence of an electrolyte, this combination also generates a direct electrical current and causes corrosion at the anodic area.

If steel or ductile iron piping is directly buried, it must be coated or insulated to reduce the potential for corrosion. For ductile iron piping, polyethylene sleeves are available and provide some degree of corrosion protection, although not to the same degree as a continuous-coated welded-steel piping system. In addition to any coating or protective sleeve systems, it may be necessary or advisable to provide a cathodic protection system for uninsulated steel or ductile iron piping.

Cathodic protection is a standard method used by the underground pipeline industry to further protect coated steel against corrosion but is not required for nonmetallic systems or preinsulated systems with a nonmetallic jacket. Cathodic protection systems are routinely designed for a minimum life of 20 years. Cathodic protection may be achieved by the sacrificial anode method or the impressed current method.

Sacrificial anode systems are normally used with well-coated structures. A direct current is applied to the outer surface of the steel structure with a potential driving force that prevents the current from leaving the steel structure. This potential is created by connecting the steel structure to another metal, such as magnesium, aluminum, or zinc, which becomes the anode and forces the steel structure to be

the cathode. The moist soil acts as the electrolyte. These deliberately connected materials become the sacrificial anode and corrode. If they generate sufficient current, they adequately protect the coated structure, and their low current output is not apt to corrode other metallic structures in the vicinity.

Impressed current systems use a rectifier to convert an alternating current power source to usable direct current. The current is distributed to the metallic structure to be protected through relatively inert anodes such as graphite or high-silicon cast iron. The rectifier allows the current to be adjusted over the life of the system. Impressed current systems, also called rectified systems, are used on long pipelines in existing systems with insufficient coatings, on marine facilities, and on any structure where current requirements are high. They are installed selectively in congested pipe areas to ensure that other buried metallic structures are not damaged.

The design of effective cathodic protection requires information on the diameter of both the carrier pipe and conduit casing, length of run, number of conduits in a common trench, and number of system terminations in access areas, buildings, etc. Soil from the construction area should be analyzed to determine the soil resistivity, or the ease with which current flows through the soil. Areas of low soil resistivity require fewer anodes to generate the required cathodic protection current, but the life of the system depends on the mass of anode material used. The design life expectancy of the cathodic protection must also be defined. All anode material is theoretically used up at the end of the cathodic protection system life. At this point, the corrosion cell reverts to the unprotected system and corrosion occurs at points along the conduit system or buried metallic structure. Anodes may be replaced or added periodically to continue the cathodic protection and increase the conduit life.

A cathodically protected system must be electrically isolated at all points where the pipe is connected to building or access port piping and where a new system is connected to an existing system. Conduits are generally tied to another building or access piping with flanged connections. Flange isolation kits, including dielectric gaskets, washers, and bolt sleeves, electrically isolate the cathodically protected structure. If an isolation flange is not used, any connecting piping or metallic structure will be in the protection system, *but protection may not be adequate*.

The effectiveness of cathodic protection can only be determined by an installation survey after the system has been energized. Cathodically protected structures should be tested at regular intervals to determine the continued effectiveness and life expectancy of the system. Sacrificial anode cathodic protection is monitored by measuring the potential (voltage) between the underground metallic structure and the soil versus a stable reference. This potential is measured with a high resistance voltmeter and a reference cell. The most commonly used reference cell material is copper/copper sulfate. One criterion for protection of buried steel structures is a negative voltage of at least 0.85 V as measured between the structure surface and a saturated copper/copper sulfate reference electrode in contact with the electrolyte. Impressed current systems require more frequent and detailed monitoring than sacrificial anode systems. The rectified current and potential output and operation must be verified and recorded at monthly intervals.

NACE *Standard* RPO169 has further information on control of external corrosion on buried metallic structures.

Leak Detection

The conduit may require excavation to repair construction errors after burial. Various techniques are available for detecting leaks in district heating and cooling piping. They range from performing periodic pressure tests on the piping system to installing a sensor cable or wire along the entire length of the piping to continuously detect and locate leaks. Most sensor cable (located in the air gap of the conduit) and wire (located within the insulation) leak detection systems can be connected to a building automation system and monitored 24 h/day and alarm when moisture is detected. Pressure testing should be performed on all piping to verify integrity during installation and the life of the piping. Chilled-water systems should be pressure tested during the winter, and hot-water and steam systems tested during the summer.

A leak is difficult to locate without the aid of a cable type leak detector. Finding a leak typically involves excavating major sections between valve vaults. Infrared detectors and acoustic detectors can help narrow down the location of a leak, but they do not work equally well for all underground systems. Also, they are not as accurate with underground systems as with an aboveground system.

Chilled- and Hot-Water Systems. Chilled-water piping systems are usually insulated with urethane foam with a vaporproof jacket (HDPE, urethane, PVC, CPVC, etc.). Copper wires can be installed during fabrication to aid in detecting and locating liquid leaks. The wires may be insulated or uninsulated, depending on the manufacturer. Some systems monitor the entire wire length, whereas others only monitor at the joints of the piping system. The detectors either look for a short in the circuit using Ohm's law or monitor for impedance change using time domain reflectometry (TDR).

Steam, High-Temperature Hot-Water, and Other Conduit Systems. Air gap designs, which have a gap between the inner wall of the outer casing and the insulation, can have probes installed at the low points of drains or at various points to detect leaks. Leaks can also be detected with a continuous cable that monitors liquid leakage. The cable is installed at the bottom of the conduit with a minimum air gap required, typically 25 mm. Pull points or access ports are installed every 120 to 150 m on straight runs, with changes in direction reducing the length between pull points. Systems monitor either by looking for a short on the cable using Ohm's law or by sensing the impedance on a coaxial cable using resistance temperature devices (RTDs). During installation, care must be taken to keep the system clean and dry to keep any contamination from the leak detection system that might cause it to fail. The system must be sealed airtight to prevent condensation from accumulating in the piping at the low points.

Geotechnical Considerations

Underground district heating or cooling distribution systems have more stringent burial requirements than most other building utilities. These piping systems normally have the coatings or jackets needed for corrosion protection, or insulation protection that must not be damaged by rocks, debris, or construction equipment. Thus, proper burial conditions must be established for the district heating or cooling distribution system to achieve its design life. Requirements vary, and manufacturers of the piping system should be able to provide guidance specific to their system. It is the EOR's responsibility to ensure that these requirements are included in the contract documents. Preferably, a licensed geotechnical engineer familiar with local conditions should conduct a site survey before construction, to recommend any soil testing required and to develop the specifications for excavation and backfill. The geotechnical and structural engineer should also be responsible for designing any thrust blocks or anchors that are needed, based on forces provided by the EOR.

In general, trenches must be overexcavated by at least 100 mm in depth to remove any unyielding material; overexcavation may need to be greater at the locations of the field joints, depending on the type of system and construction method. The overexcavation is generally filled with a select backfill material; normally, this is a sandy, noncohesive material free of any stones greater than 19 mm. Any unstable materials encountered in the excavation should be removed and properly backfilled and compacted. The selected

backfill in the trench bottom should be prepared to achieve the minimum slope for the carrier pipe of 10 mm in 2.4 m (0.4%) and compacted to 95% of laboratory maximum density per ASTM *Standard* D698. Some of the methods of carrier pipe joining, such as welding, require a working area around the entire circumference of the field joint; one way to achieve this is to overexcavate under the pipe, and potentially even at the sides of the trench at the locations of the field joints. If this is done, be sure to fully compact the backfill material under the field joint area.

Another method to provide working clearance for making the field joint is to block the piping up off the bottom of the trench during that process. When this method is used, care must be taken to block the pipe sufficiently to achieve proper alignment for joining and to emulate the pipe as it will ultimately lie on the sloped trench bottom. Once the field joints have been completed, remove the blocking and carefully and uniformly place the piping in the prepared trench bottom. The blocking should not be left in place, because this creates point loading on the piping and may contribute to differential settlement as well. In some situations when welded-steel piping is used, for example, it may be possible to join two sections of piping together adjacent to the trench and then lift the assembly in as a unit and thus reduce the work required in the trench.

The elevation of the trench bottom must not have slope reversals between valve vaults and building entry locations. After the piping is placed in the trench and all field joints and pressure tests have been completed, immediately before backfilling, the elevation of the top invert of the pipe/jacket should be taken at each pipe section midpoint and field joint. These elevations should be recorded and subsequently transferred to the as-built drawings. Backfill of the piping should then be accomplished in layers of no more than 150 mm with the same select backfill material used for the pipe bedding. The selected backfill should be extended to approximately 300 mm above the top of the pipe or jacketing. Include buried utility warning tape in the trench at this depth. Compaction of this backfill material should also be to 95% of laboratory maximum density per ASTM *Standard* D698. Ensure that the backfill adequately fills the void created under the pipe and between the supply and return pipes. Also, take care not to damage any pipe coating or insulation jacketing material; if any such damage does occur, repair it according to the pipe system manufacturer's field repair instructions. Final backfill of the remainder of the trench should be accomplished using the native soil (removing any stones greater than75 mm), compacted in layers of no more than 150 mm. This final backfill should be compacted to 95% of laboratory maximum density per ASTM *Standard* D698 for noncohesive soils, or 90% of laboratory maximum density per ASTM *Standard* D698 for cohesive soils. Note that it is not advisable to complete the final backfilling with anything other than native soil, because the permeability of other substances may be much different than that of the native material. For example, using a permeable backfill material in an impermeable native soil is essentially placing the district heating or cooling system in a drainage ditch for surface water.

Also, note that horizontal boring, jacking, and microtunneling have become popular methods of installing buried pipelines where the normal cut-and-cover methods described previously may be difficult or impossible, or simply cost prohibitive. These alternative burial methods preclude the use of protective backfilling, but often may not need such steps. However, metallic pipelines must still be protected from corrosion, and methods appropriate for the installation method must be used.

Valve Vaults and Entry Pits

Manholes or valve vaults may be required on underground distribution systems to provide access to underground systems at critical points, such as high or low points that vent trapped air or where the system can be drained; where elevation changes in the distribution system are needed to maintain the required constant or nonreversing slope (a slope of 1:240 is a reasonable and achievable construction value); and to access isolation valves at major distribution system branches. Phetteplace et al. (2013b) contains a detailed discussion on valve vaults.

The term **vault** is used to eliminate confusion with sanitary manholes. Valve vaults are important when the underground distribution system cannot be maintained without excavation, as is the case for all direct-buried district cooling piping systems. They allow for step elevation changes in the distribution system piping, while maintaining an acceptable slope on the system; they also allow the designer to better match the topography and avoid unreasonable and expensive burial depths. However, they also have a significant potential to generate maintenance requirements of their own, and any problems, if left uncorrected, can cascade into the adjacent buried portions of the distribution system.

Valve vaults allow a user to isolate one segment of a system rather than analyze the entire system or a large section thereof. Isolation may be for routine maintenance as well as for operational problems or failures. This feature is important if the underground distribution system cannot be maintained between valve vaults without excavation. The optimum number of valve vaults is that which affords the lowest life-cycle cost and still meets all design requirements, typically around 204 m apart but usually no more than 150 m apart in the absence of other requirements, such as isolation valves for a building service. Valve vaults provide a space in which to put valves, steam traps, carrier pipe drains, carrier pipe vents, casing vents and drains, condensate pumping units, condensate cooling devices, flash tanks, expansion joints, groundwater drains, electrical leak detection equipment and wiring, electrical isolation couplings, branch line isolation valves, carrier pipe isolation valves, and flowmeters. Valve vaults allow for elevation changes in the distribution system piping while maintaining an acceptable slope on the system; they also allow the designer to better match the topography and avoid unreasonable and expensive burial depths.

Penetrations. One of the basic functions of a valve vault is to provide a dry, corrosion-free environment for the piping and appurtenances in the valve vault. This means that the vault walls must not let groundwater enter the vault. Typical types of penetrations of the vault walls are the district cooling piping, electrical service conduits, sump pump discharge pipes, and sanitary drains. All penetrations must have a method to provide a positive water seal between the vault wall and the pipe or electrical conduit. Often, a leak plate is welded to a steel sleeve that is cast into the concrete vault wall. Existing vault walls or precast valve vaults that do not have the leak plate cast into the wall may still be sealed acceptably, as long as the surface of the wall penetration is smooth and an adequate seal can be achieved. The annular space between the outside of the piping/conduit and the valve vault wall penetration is typically sealed with a link seal or other type of adjustable compressed rubber seal. These rubber seals work poorly where construction quality control is poor, because the holes in the vault wall are often the wrong diameter or are irregular. Piping that penetrates the vault wall at an angle causes especially difficult sealing problems for precast construction when the hole in the vault wall is not perpendicular to the conduit. In addition, for some nonmetallic systems, the casing of the district heating or cooling pipe tends to deflect when the seal exerts the radial compressive load it needs to achieve the water seal. When plastic piping or casings are used, a special design is needed to prevent radial deflection, or some other type of sealing method is required.

Ponding Water. The most significant problem with valve vaults is that water ponds in them. Ponding water may be from either carrier pipe leaks or intrusion of surface or groundwater into the valve vault. When the hot- and chilled-water distribution systems share the same valve vault, plastic chilled-water lines often fail because

ponded water heats the plastic to failure. Water gathers in the valve vault irrespective of climate; therefore, design strives to eliminate the water for the entire life of the underground distribution system. If the system depth allows, the most successful water removal systems are those that drain to sanitary or storm drainage systems; this technique is successful because the system is affected very little by corrosion and has no moving parts to fail. Backwater valves are recommended in the event of the drainage system backing up.

Duplex sump pumps with lead-lag controllers and a failure annunciation system are used when storm drains and sanitary drains are not accessible or the collection point is below adjacent sewers. Because pumps have a history of frequent failures, duplex pumps help eliminate short cycling and provide standby pumping capacity. Steam ejector pumps can be used only if the distribution system is never shut down because the carrier pipe insulation can be severely damaged during even short outages. A labeled, lockable, dedicated electrical service should be used for electric pumps. The circuit label should indicate what the circuit is used for; it should also warn of the damage that will occur if the circuit is deenergized.

Electrical components have experienced accelerated corrosion in the high heat and humidity of closed, unventilated vaults. A pump that works well at 10°C often performs poorly at 95°C and 100% rh. To resolve this problem, one approach specifies components that have demonstrated high reliability at 95°C and 100% rh with a damp-proof electrical service. The pump should have a corrosion-resistant shaft (when immersed in water) and impeller and have demonstrated 200 000 cycles of successful operation, including the electrical switching components, at the referenced temperature and humidity. The pump must also pass foreign matter; therefore, the ability to pass a 10 mm ball should be specified.

Another method drains the valve vaults into a separate sump adjacent to the vault. Then the pumps are placed in this sump, which is cool and more nearly a sump pump environment. Redundant methods may be necessary if maximum reliability is needed or future maintenance is questionable. The pump can discharge to the sanitary or storm drain or to a splash block near the valve vault. Water pumped to a splash block has a tendency to enter the vault, but this is not a significant problem if the vault construction joints have been sealed properly. Extreme caution must be used if the bottom of the valve vault has French drains, which allow groundwater to enter the vault and flood the insulation on the distribution system during high-groundwater conditions. Adequate ventilation of the valve vault is also important.

Crowding of Components. The valve vault must be laid out in three dimensions, considering standing room for the worker, wrench swings, the size of valve operators, variation between manufacturers in the size of appurtenances, and all other variations that the specifications allow with respect to any item placed in the vault. To achieve desired results, the vault layout must be shown to scale on the contract drawings.

High Humidity. High humidity develops in a valve vault when it has no positive ventilation. Gravity ventilation is often provided, in which cool air enters the valve vault and sinks to the bottom. At the bottom of the vault, the air warms, becomes lighter, and rises to the top of the vault, where it exits. In the past, some designers used a closed-top valve vault with an exterior ventilation pipe with an elbow that directs the exiting air down. However, the elbowed-down vent hood tends to trap the exiting air and prevent gravity ventilation from working. Open structural grate tops are the most successful covers for ventilation purposes. Open grates allow rain to enter the vault; however, the techniques mentioned in the section on Ponding Water are sufficient to handle the rainwater. Open grates with sump basins have worked well in extremely cold climates and in warm climates. Some vaults have a closed top and screened, elevated sides to allow free ventilation. In this design, the solid vault sides extend slightly above grade; then, a screened window is placed in the wall on at least two sides. The overall above-grade height may be only 450 mm.

High Temperatures. The temperature in the valve vault rises when no systematic way is provided to remove heat losses from the distribution system. The gravity ventilation rate is usually not sufficient to transport heat from the closed vaults. Part of this heat transfers to the earth; however, an equilibrium temperature is reached that may be higher than desired. Ventilation techniques discussed in the section on High Humidity can resolve the problem of high temperature if the heat loss from the distribution system is near normal. Typical problems that greatly increase the amount of heat released include

- Leaks from a carrier pipe, gaskets, packings, or appurtenances
- Insulation that has deteriorated because of flooding or abuse
- Standing water in a vault that touches the distribution pipe
- Steam vented to the vault from partial flooding between valve vaults
- Vents from flash tanks
- Insulation removed during routine maintenance and not replaced

To prevent heat release in a new system, a workable ventilation system must be designed. On existing valve vaults, the valve vault must be ventilated properly, all leaks corrected, and all insulation that was damaged or left off replaced. Commercially available insulation jackets that can easily be removed and reinstalled from fittings and valves should be installed. If flooding occurs between valve vaults, portions of the distribution system may have to be excavated and repaired or replaced. Vents from vault appurtenances that exhaust steam into the vault may have to be routed aboveground if the ventilation technique is insufficient to handle the quantity of steam exhausted.

Deep Burial. When a valve vault is buried too deeply, (1) the structure is exposed to groundwater pressures, (2) entry and exit often become a safety problem, (3) construction becomes more difficult, and (4) the cost of the vault is greatly increased. Ideally, valve vault spacing should be less than 150 m (NAS 1975). If greater spacing is desired, use an accurate life-cycle analysis to determine spacing. The most common way to limit burial depth is to place the valve vaults closer together. Sawtooth-shaped steps in the distribution system slope are accommodated in the valve vault (i.e., the carrier pipes enter the valve vault at a low elevation and leave at a higher elevation). If the slope of the distribution system is changed to more nearly match the earth topography, the valve vaults will be shallower; however, the allowable range of slope of the carrier pipes restricts this method. In most systems, the slope of the distribution system can be reversed in a valve vault, but not out in the system between valve vaults. The minimum slope for the carrier pipes is 4 mm/m. Lower slopes are outside the range of normal construction tolerance. If the entire distribution system is buried too deeply, the designer must determine the maximum allowable burial depth of the system and survey the topography of the distribution system to determine where the maximum and minimum depth of burial will occur. All elevations must be adjusted to limit the minimum and maximum allowable burial depths.

Freezing Conditions. Failure of distribution systems caused by water freezing in components is common. The designer must consider the coldest temperature that may occur at a site and not the 99% or 99.6% condition used in building design (as discussed in Chapter 27 of the 2013 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). Drain legs or vent legs that allow water to stagnate are usually the cause of failure. Insulation should be on all items that can freeze, and it must be kept in good condition. Electrical heat tape and pipe-type heat tracing can be used under insulation. If part of a chilled-water system is in a ventilated valve vault, the chilled water may have to be circulated or be drained if not used in winter.

Safety and Access. Some working fluids used in underground distribution systems can cause severe injury and death if accidentally

released in a confined space such as a valve vault. The shallow valve vault with large openings is desirable because it allows personnel to escape quickly in an emergency. The layout of the pipes and appurtenances must allow easy access for maintenance without requiring maintenance personnel to crawl underneath or between other pipes. The goal of the designer is to keep clear work spaces for maintenance personnel so that they can work efficiently and, if necessary, exit quickly. Engineering drawings must show pipe insulation thickness; otherwise they will give a false impression of the available space.

The location and type of ladder is important for safety and ease of egress. It is best to lay out the ladder and access openings when laying out the valve vault pipes and appurtenances as a method of exercising control over safety and ease of access. Ladder steps, when cast in the concrete vault walls, may corrode if not constructed of the correct material. Corrosion is most common in steel rungs. Either cast-iron or prefabricated, OSHA-approved, galvanized steel ladders that sit on the valve vault floor and are anchored near the top to hold it into position are best. If the design uses lockable access doors, the locks must be operable from inside or have some keyed-open device that allows workers to keep the key while working in the valve vault. Extremely deep vaults (greater than 6 m) may require an intermediate landing and caged ladder with fall protection to satisfy OSHA requirements.

Vault Construction. The most successful valve vaults are those constructed of cast-in-place reinforced concrete. These vaults conform to the earth excavation profile and show little movement when backfilled properly. Leakproof connections can be made with mating tunnels and conduit casings, even though they may enter or leave at oblique angles. In contrast, prefabricated valve vaults may settle and move after construction is complete. Penetrations for prefabricated vaults, as well as the angles of entry and exit, are difficult to locate exactly. As a result, much of the work associated with penetrations is not detailed and must be done by construction workers in the field, which greatly lowers the quality and greatly increases the chances of a groundwater leak.

Construction Deficiencies. Construction deficiencies that go unnoticed in buildings can destroy a cooling distribution system; therefore, the designer must clearly convey to the contractor that a valve vault does not behave like a sanitary manhole. A design that is sufficient for a sanitary manhole will cause the appurtenances in district heating or cooling distribution system manholes to fail prematurely because many of the requirements mentioned previously are not provided.

Construction of Systems Without Valve Vaults. Uninsulated systems have been designed where features such as valves are directly buried and then remotely operated, much the same as is frequently done for potable water distribution systems. For this approach to be successful for an insulated system, a continuous, high-integrity jacket system as well as the necessary seals for operable shafts, etc., must be provided. If the waterproofing is not entirely successful, groundwater will enter the system, causing corrosion and deterioration of the insulation's thermal properties. Adequately waterproofing features (e.g., direct-burial valves, vents/drains) is very difficult to do in the field. The standardized European preinsulated piping systems developed originally for low-temperature, hot-water systems are factory prefabricated.

4. CONSUMER INTERCONNECTIONS

The thermal energy produced at the plant is transported via the distribution network and is finally transferred to the consumer. This end user interface connection is also commonly called an **energy transfer station (ETS)**.

When thermal energy (hot water, steam, or chilled water) is supplied, it may be used directly by the building HVAC system or process loads, or indirectly via a heat exchanger that transfers energy from one media to another. When energy is used directly, it may need to be reduced to pressure that is commensurate to the buildings' systems. The design engineer must perform an analysis to determine which connection type is best.

For commercially operated systems, a contract boundary or point of delivery divides responsibilities between the energy provider and the customer. This point can be at a piece of equipment, as in a heat exchanger with an indirect connection, or flanges as in a direct connection. It is highly recommended that a chemical treatment analysis be performed (regardless of the type of connection) to determine the compatibility of each side of the system (district and consumer) before energizing. Whether the connection is direct or indirect or heating or cooling, a cathodic isolation flange is recommended at the ETS to preserve system pipe integrity, especially when connecting to older buildings (Sperko 2009; Tredinnick 2008a). See Phetteplace et al. (2013, 2019) and Tredinnick et al. (2019) for additional information.

There are traditionally two types of interfaces with a customer: direct or indirect connection. Advantages and disadvantages of each are summarized in Table 13.

Chilled- and hot-water ETSs may be constant or variable flow, depending on the building's HVAC system. However, variable flow is recommended for both chilled- and hot-water systems because of energy savings and the need to comply with current requirements of ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1. Typically, constant-flow systems are found in older buildings and may be converted to simulate a variable-flow system by blocking off the bypass line around the air handler heat exchanger coil three-way control valve. At low operating pressures, this potentially may convert a three-way bypass-type valve to a two-way modulating control valve. The valve actuator must be carefully analyzed, because shutoff requirements and control characteristics are totally different for a two-way valve compared to a three-way valve.

4.1 DIRECT CONNECTIONS

Because a direct connection offers no barrier between the district water and the building's own system (e.g., air-handling unit cooling and heating coils, fan-coils, radiators, unit heaters, process loads), the water circulated at the district plant has the same quality as the customer's water (and vice versa). Direct connections, therefore, are at a greater risk of incurring damage or contamination based on the poor water quality of either party. Typically, district systems have contracts with water treatment vendors and monitor water quality continuously. This may not be the case with all consumers. A direct connection is often more economical than an indirect connection because the consumer is not burdened by the installation of heat exchangers, additional circulation pumps, or water treatment systems; therefore, investment costs are reduced and return temperatures identical to design values are possible.

In general, consider using a direct connection under the following conditions: the building owner is the district system owner or they are related entities; control of first cost is important; buildings are generally low rise; building systems are new or in good condition; in-building space for interconnection is limited; and the building owner, if different than the district utility, respects the need for high Δt and will maintain the building systems accordingly and retrofit the building equipment where necessary to achieve adequate Δt.

Figures 26 and 27 show a simple chilled-water direct connection using building circulation pumps and using the district cooling provider's pumps, respectively. Figure 27's method is preferred, because it is the simplest, with no control valve, but must have high return water temperatures at varying flows. Consequently, this method requires the building design engineer and controls contractor to implement a design that operates per the design intent. See the

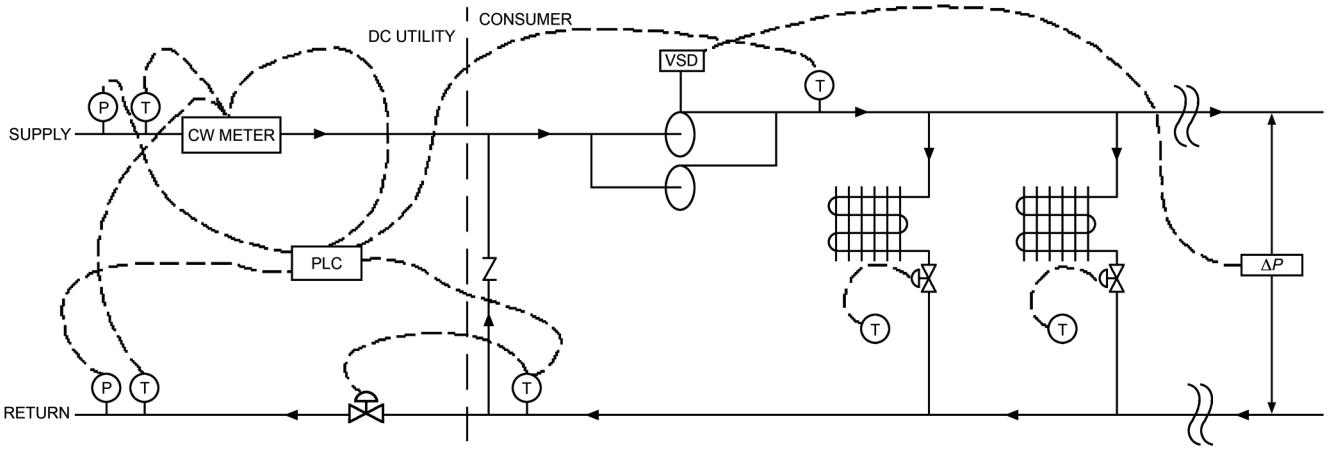


Fig. 26 Direct Connection of Building System to District Chilled Water with Building Pumps

(Phetteplace et al. 2019)

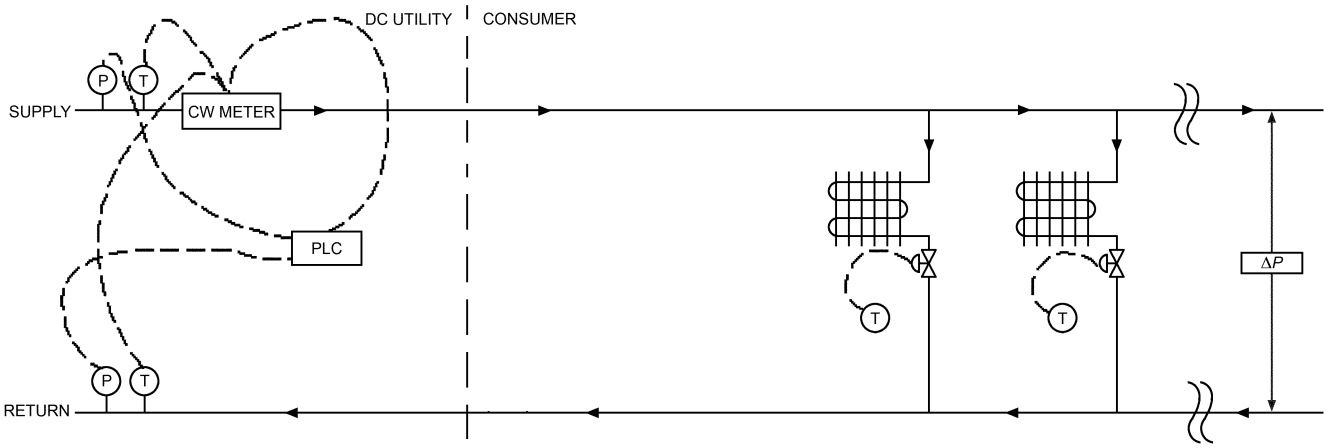


Fig. 27 Direct Connection of Building System to District Chilled Water Without Building Pumps

(Phetteplace et al. 2019)

Temperature Differential Control section for further discussion regarding achieving high system Δt.

Similarly, Figure 28 shows the simplest form of hot-water direct connection, where the district heating plant pumps water through the consumer building. This figure includes a pressure differential regulator (which may be required to reduce system differential pressure to meet any lower building system parameters), a thermostatic control valve on each terminal unit, and a pressure relief valve. Most commercial systems have a flowmeter installed as well as temperature sensors and transmitters to calculate the energy used. Pressure transmitters may be installed as input for plant circulating pump speed control. The location of each device may vary from system to system, but all of the major components are indicated. The control valve is the capacity regulating device that restricts flow to maintain either a water supply or return temperature on the consumer's side.

Particular attention must be paid to connecting high-rise buildings because they induce a static head that affects the design pressure of the entire system. Pressure control devices should be investigated carefully. It is not unusual to have a water-based district heating or cooling system with a mixture of direct and indirect connections in which heat exchangers isolate the systems hydraulically based on the location of the ETS in the building and the number of floors served.

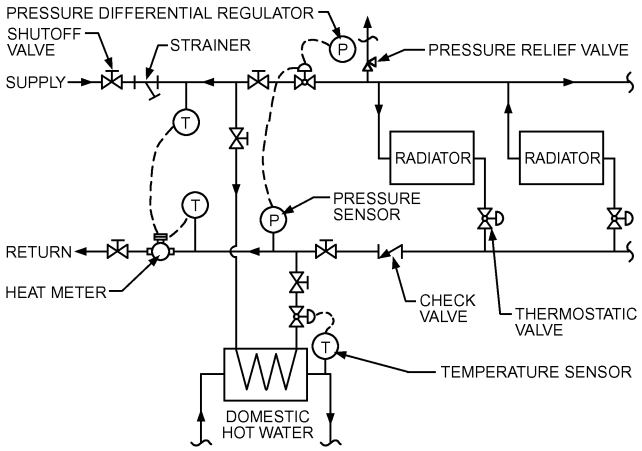


Fig. 28 Direct Connection of Building System to District Hot Water

In a direct connected system, the pressure in the main distribution system must meet local building codes to protect the customer's installation and the reliability of the district system. To minimize

noise, cavitation, and control problems, constant-pressure differential control valves should be installed in the buildings. Special attention should be given to potential noise problems at the control valves. These valves must correspond to the design pressure differential in a system that has constantly varying distribution pressures because of load shifts. Multiple valves may be required to serve the load under all flow and pressure ranges. Industrial-quality valves and actuators should be used for this application.

If the temperature supplied from the main distribution system is lower than that required in the consumer cooling systems, a larger temperature differential between supply and return occurs, thus reducing the required pipe size. The consumer's desired supply temperature can be attained by mixing return water with district cooling supply water. Depending on the size and design of the main system, elevation differences, and types of customers and building systems, additional safety equipment (e.g., automatic shutoff valves on both supply and return lines) may be required.

When buildings have separate circulation pumps, primary/secondary piping, and pumping, isolating techniques are used (cross-connection bridge between return and supply piping, decouplers, and bypass lines). This ensures that terminal unit two-way control valves are subjected only to the differential pressure established by the customer's building (tertiary) pump. Figure 25 shows a primary/secondary connection using an in-building pumping scheme.

When tertiary pumps are used, all series connections between the district system pumps must be removed. A series connection can cause the district system return to operate at a higher pressure than the distribution system supply and disrupt normal flow patterns. Series operation usually occurs during improper use of three-way mixing valves in the primary to secondary connection. For similar reasons, booster pumps in chilled-water return lines back to the plant are discouraged.

4.2 INDIRECT CONNECTIONS

Many of the components are similar to those used in the direct connection applications, with the exception that a heat exchanger performs one or more of the following functions: heat transfer, pressure interception, and buffer between potentially different quality water treatments.

Identical to the direct connection, the rate of energy extraction in the heat exchanger is governed by a control valve that reacts to the building load demand. Once again, the control valve usually modulates to maintain a temperature set point on either side of the heat exchanger, depending on the contractual agreement between the consumer and the producer.

The three major advantages of using heat exchangers are (1) the static head influences of a high-rise building are eliminated, (2) the two water streams are separated, and (3) consumers must make up all of their own lost water. The primary disadvantages of using an indirect connection are the (1) additional cost of the heat exchanger, (2) temperature loss caused by the approach of the heat exchanger, and (3) increased pumping pressure because of the addition of another heat transfer surface. Figure 29 shows a typical district chilled-water indirect connection, and Figure 30 shows a cascading district heating indirect connection where the domestic hot-water heat exchanger (HX) is supplied from the comfort HX outlet piping for greater Δt across the connection.

4.3 STEAM CONNECTIONS

Although higher pressures and temperatures are sometimes used, most district heating systems supply saturated steam at pressures between 35 and 1000 kPa (gage) to customers' facilities. The steam is pretreated to maintain a neutral pH, and the condensate is cooled and discharged to the building sewage system (not preferred) or returned back to the central plant for recycling (preferred). Many consumers run the condensate through a heat exchanger to heat the domestic hot-water supply of the building before returning it to the central plant or, sometimes, to the building drains if the district system does not have a condensate return pipe. This energy-saving process extracts the maximum amount of energy out of the delivered steam. Again, it is best to return the condensate back to the plant whenever the system configuration dictates, but there still are some vintage single-pipe steam systems in operation that are 100% makeup water systems. The designer should coordinate with the district energy provider to confirm the requirements.

Interconnection between the district and the building is simple when the building uses the steam directly in heating coils or radiators or for process loads (humidification, kitchen, laundry, laboratory, steam absorption chillers, or turbine-driven devices). Other buildings extract the energy from the district steam via a steam-to-water heat exchanger to generate hot water and circulate it to the air-side terminal units. Typical installations are shown in Figures 31 and 32. Chapter 11 has additional information on building distribution piping, valving, traps, and other system requirements. The type of steam chemical treatment should be considered in applications for the food industry and for humidification (Tredinnick 2008b).

Other components of the steam connection may include condensate pumps, flowmeters (steam and/or condensate), and condensate conductivity probes, which may dump condensate if contaminated by unacceptable debris. Often, energy meters are installed on both the steam and condensate pipes to allow the district energy supplier to determine how much energy is used directly and how much energy (condensate) is not returned back to the plant. Using customer energy meters for both steam and condensate is desirable for the following reasons:

- Offers redundant metering (if the condensate meter fails, the steam meter can detect flow or vice versa)
- Bills customer accordingly for makeup water and chemical treatment on all condensate that is not returned or is contaminated
- Meter is in place if customer requires direct use of steam in the future
- Assists in identifying steam and condensate leaks
- Improves customer relations (may ease customer's fears of overbilling because of a faulty meter)

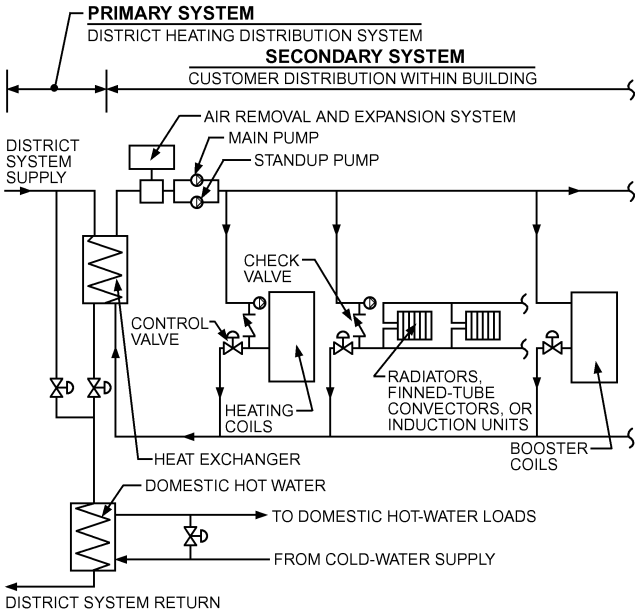


Fig. 30 Basic Cascading Indirect Heating-System Schematic

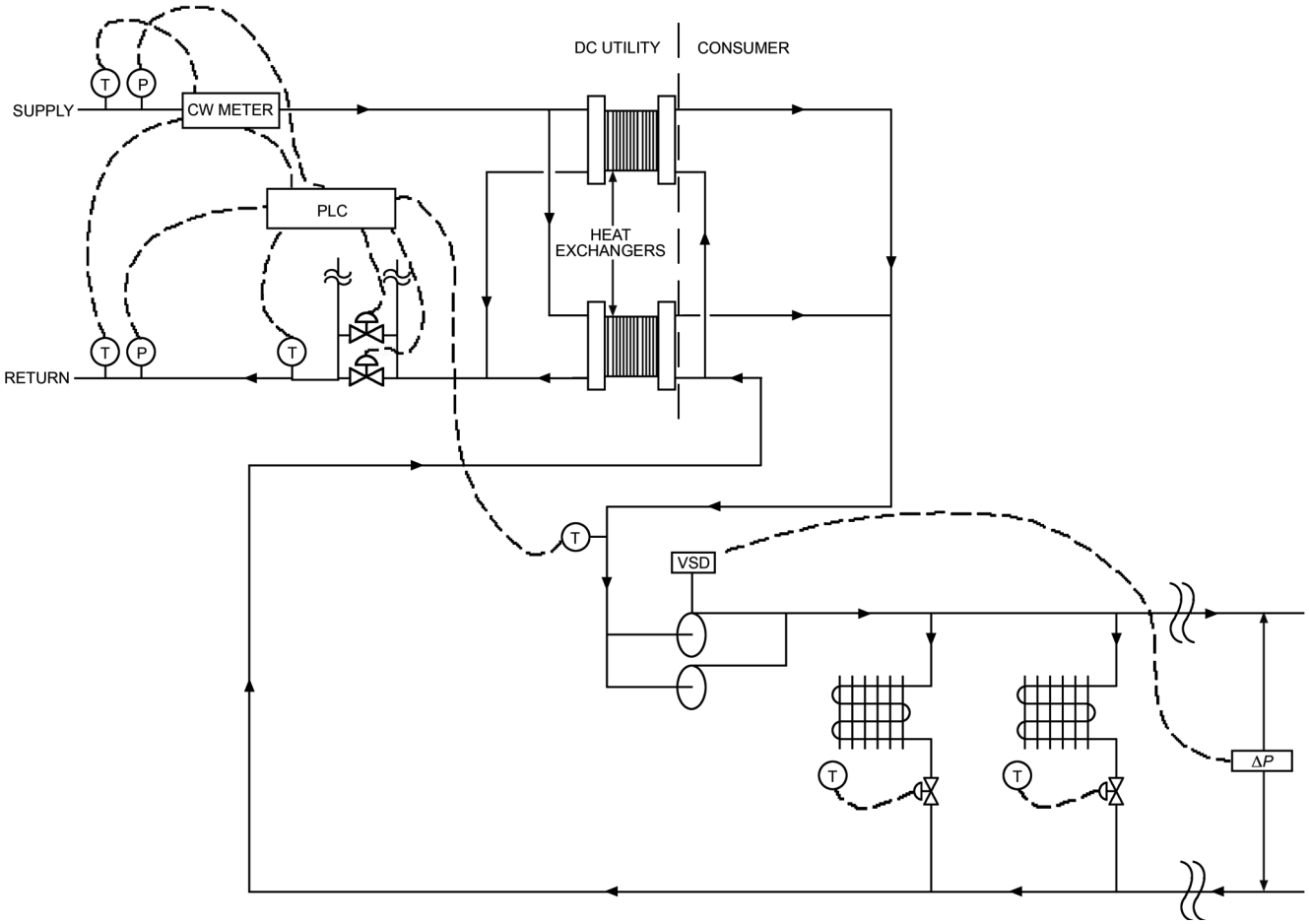


Fig. 29 Indirect Connection of Building System to District Chilled Water

(Phetteplace et al. 2019)

- Provides a more accurate reading for peak demand measurements and charges

Monitor each level of steam pressure reduction as well as the temperature of the condensate. Where conductivity probes are used to monitor the quality of water returned to the steam plant, adequate drainage and cold-water quenching equipment may be required to satisfy local plumbing code requirements (e.g., temperature of fluid discharging into a sewer). The probe status should also be monitored at the control panel, to communicate high-conductivity alarms to the plant and, when condensate is being dumped, to notify the plant that a conductivity problem exists at a customer.

Building Conversion to District Heating

Table 14 (Sleiman et al. 1990) summarizes the suitability or success rate of converting various heating systems to be served by a district hot-water system. As shown, the probability is high for water-based systems, lower for steam, and lowest for fuel oil or electric systems. Low-suitability systems usually require expensive replacement of the entire heating terminal and generating units with suitable water-based equipment, including piping, pumps, controls, and heat transfer media.

Table 13 Conversion Suitability of Heating System by Type

Type of System	Low	Medium	High
Steam equipment			
One-pipe cast iron radiation	X		
Two-pipe cast iron radiation		X	
Finned-tube radiation		X	
Air-handling unit coils		X	
Terminal unit coils	X		
Hot-water equipment			
Radiators and convectors			X
Radiant panels			X
Unitary heat pumps			X
Air-handling unit coils			X
Terminal unit coils			X
Gas/oil-fired equipment			
Warm-air furnaces	X		
Rooftop units	X		
Other systems	X		
Electric equipment			
Warm-air furnaces	X		
Rooftop units	X		
Air-to-air heat pumps	X		
Other systems	X		

Source: Sleiman et al. (1990).

4.4 COMPONENTS

Heat Exchangers

Aside from their isolation function, heat exchangers act as the line of demarcation between ownership responsibilities of the different components of an indirect system. They transfer thermal energy and act as pressure interceptors for the water pressure in high-rise buildings. They also keep fluids from each side (which may have different chemical treatments) from mixing. Figure 30 shows a basic building schematic including heat exchangers and secondary systems.

Reliability of the installation is increased if multiple heat exchangers are installed. The number selected depends on the types of loads present and how they are distributed throughout the year. When selecting all equipment for the building interconnection, but specifically heat exchangers, the designer should

- Size the unit's capacity to match the given load and estimated load turndown as close as possible (oversized units may not perform as desired at maximum turndown; therefore, using several smaller units optimizes the installation).
- Assess the critical nature of the load/operation/process to address reliability and redundancy. For example, if a building has 24 h process loads (i.e., computer room cooling, water-cooled equipment, etc.), consider adding a separate heat exchanger for this load. Also, consider operation and maintenance of the units. If the customer is a hotel, hospital, casino, or data center, select a minimum of two units at 50% load each to allow one unit to be cleaned without interrupting building service. Separate heat exchangers should be capable of automatic isolation during low-load conditions to increase part-load performance.
- Determine customer's temperature and pressure design conditions. Some gasket materials for plate heat exchangers have limits for low pressure and temperature.
- Evaluate customer's water quality (i.e., use appropriate fouling factor).
- Determine available space and structural factors of the mechanical room.
- Quantify design temperatures. The heat exchanger may require rerating at a higher inlet temperature during off-peak hours.
- Calculate allowable pressure drop on both sides of heat exchangers. The customer's side is usually the most critical for pressure drop. The higher the pressure drop, the smaller and less expensive the heat exchanger. However, the pressure drop must be kept in reasonable limits [100 kPa (gage) or below] if existing pumps are to be reused. For chilled-water connections, investigate the existing chiller evaporator pressure drop to assist in this evaluation.

Size all heat exchangers with future expansion in mind. During selection, be aware that closer approach temperatures or low pressure drop require more heat transfer area and hence cost more and take up more space. Install strainers in front of any heat exchanger and control valve to keep debris from fouling surfaces or orifices.

Plate, shell-and-coil, and shell-and-tube heat exchangers are all used for indirect connection. Whatever heat transfer device is selected must meet the appropriate temperature and pressure duty, and be stamped/certified accordingly as pressure vessels. Whether using heat exchangers for heating or cooling, it is advantageous and recommended that if one side of the unit has variable flow, the other side should as well. This ensures that minimum pump and thermal energy is used to satisfy a load (Tredinnick 2007). See Chapter 48 for more information on heat exchangers.

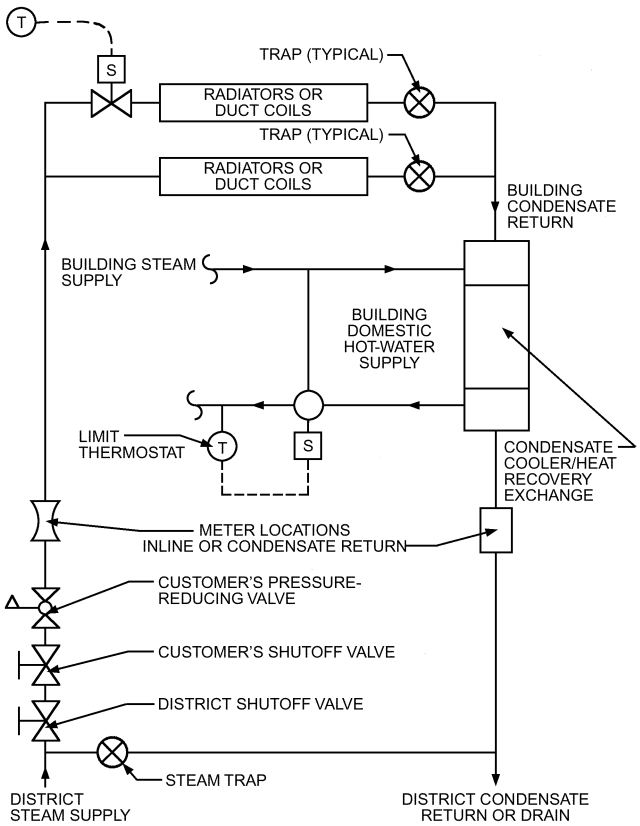


Fig. 31 District/Building Interconnection with Heat Recovery Steam System

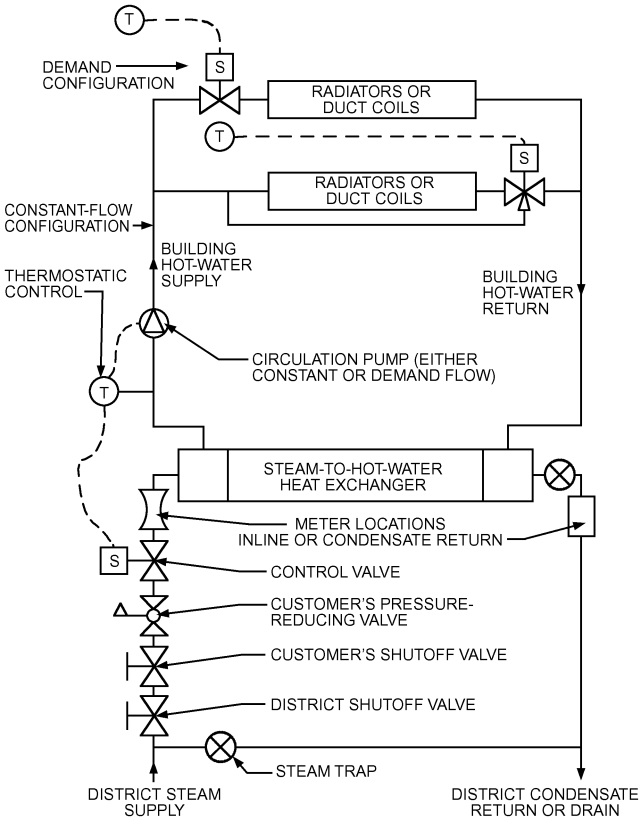


Fig. 32 District/Building Interconnection with Heat Exchange Steam System

Plate Heat Exchangers (PHEs). These exchangers, which are used for steam, hot-water, and chilled-water applications, are available as gasketed units and in two gasket-free designs (brazed and all- or semiwelded construction). All gasketed PHEs, also known as plate-and-frame heat exchangers (HXs), consist of multiple gasketed embossed metal plates bolted together between two end frames and sealed along the edges. Alternate plates are inverted and the gaps between the plates form the liquid flow channels. Fluids never mix because hot fluid flows on one side of the plate and cool fluid flows countercurrent on the other side. Ports at each corner of the end plates act as headers for the fluid. One fluid travels in the odd-numbered gaps and the other in the even-numbered gaps.

Gaskets between the plates contain the two media in the plates and act as a boundary. Gasket failure does not cause the two media to mix; instead, the media leaks to the atmosphere. Gaskets can be either glued or clipped on. Gasketed PHEs are suitable for steam-to-liquid and liquid-to-liquid applications. Designers should select the appropriate gasket material for the design temperatures and pressures expected. Plates are typically stainless steel; however, plate material can be varied based on the chemical makeup of the heat transfer fluids.

Because PHEs require turbulent flow for proper heat transfer, pressure drops may be higher than those for comparable shell-and-tube models. High efficiency leads to a smaller package. The designer should consider specifying that the frame be sized to hold 20% additional plates. PHEs require very little maintenance because the high velocity of the fluid in the channels keep surfaces clean from fouling. However, larger particles may become lodged in fine cavities between the plates and choke flow; automatic backflushing valves may be used to address this issue. PHEs generally have a cost advantage and require one-third to one-half the surface required by shell-and-tube units for the same operating conditions. PHEs are also capable of closer approach temperatures.

PHEs are typically used for district heating and cooling with water and for cooling tower water heat recovery (free cooling). Double-wall plates are also available for potable-water heating, chemical processes, and oil quenching. PHEs have three to five times greater heat transfer coefficients than shell-and-tube units and can achieve 0.5 K approach, but for economic reasons the approach is traditionally 1 K. Gasketed PHEs can be disassembled in the field to clean the plates and replace the gaskets. Typical applications go up to 185°C and 2.8 MPa (gage). Plates are typically made from stainless steel, but are available in titanium for more corrosive uses such as seawater cooling.

Brazed PHEs are suitable for steam, vapor, or water solutions. They feature a close approach temperature (within 1 K), large temperature drop, compact size, and a high heat transfer coefficient. Construction materials are stainless steel plates and sometimes frames brazed together with copper or nickel. Tightening bolts are not required as with the gasketed design. These units cannot be disassembled and cleaned; therefore, adequate strainers must be installed ahead of an exchanger and it must be periodically flushed clean in a normal maintenance program. Brazed PHEs usually peak at a capacity of under 60 kW (about 200 plates and 0.04 m^3/s) and are suitable for 3 MPa and 225°C. Typical applications are district heating using hot water and refrigeration process loads. Double-wall plates are also available for domestic hot-water use. Avoid applications where the PHE may be exposed to large, sudden, or frequent changes in temperature and load, because of risk of thermal fatigue.

Welded PHEs can be used in any application for which shell-and-tube units are used that are outside the accepted range of gasketed PHE units, in liquid-to-liquid, steam-to-liquid, gas-to-liquid, gas-to-gas, and refrigerant applications. Construction is very similar to gasketed units except gaskets are replaced with laser welds. Materials are typically stainless steel, but titanium, monel, nickel, and various alloys are available. Models have design ratings that range from 260°C at 1 MPa to 540°C at 6.7 MPa; however, they are available only in small sizes. Normally, these units are used in ammonia refrigeration and aggressive process fluids. They are more suitable to pressure pulsation or thermal cycling because they are thermal fatigue resistant. A semiwelded PHE is a hybrid of the gasketed and the all-welded units in which the plates are alternatively sealed with gaskets and welds.

Shell-and-Coil Heat Exchangers. These European-designed heat exchangers are suitable for steam-to-water and water-to-water applications and feature an all-welded-and-brazed construction. This counter/cross-flow heat exchanger consists of a hermetically sealed (no gaskets), carbon-steel pressure vessel with hemispherical heads. Copper or stainless helical tubes within are installed in a vertical configuration. This type of heat exchanger offers a high temperature drop and close approach temperature. Its vertical arrangement requires less floor space than other designs and has better heat transfer characteristics than shell-and-tube units.

Shell-and-Tube Heat Exchangers. These exchangers are usually a multiple-pass design. The shell is usually constructed from steel and the tubes are often of U-bend construction, usually 20 mm (nominal) OD copper, but other materials are available. These units are ASME U-1 stamped for pressure vessels.

Heat Exchanger Load Characteristics. To provide high Δt under multiple load conditions, variable flow is required on both sides of the heat exchanger (Perdue and Ansbro 1999; Skagestad and Mildenstein 2002; Tredinnick 2007). Without variable flow on the customer side, more water flow is required on the district side during reduced load. This condition results in both increased pumping for the district energy provider as well as reduced Δt. In addition, the customer side also experiences increased pumping costs without the use of variable flow. The specific degradation in Δt and the increases in flow depend on the actual heat exchanger selection, and can easily be determined for a specific heat exchanger by selection and sizing software available from the heat exchanger manufacturer.

An example provided by Skagestad and Mildenstein (2002) for a 1500 kW design load indicates that, at 50% load and constant flow on the consumer side, 75% of the design flow would be required on the district cooling system side, compared to 45% if the consumer side used variable flow. However, consumer-side constant flow reduces the Δt from the design value of 8.3 K to just 5.6 K at 50% load; when variable flow is used on the consumer's side of the PHE, the Δt actually increased from the design value of 8.3 K to 9.3 K.

Another example of the need for variable-flow pumping on the consumer's side of PHE is provided by Tredinnick (2007) for a 1758 kW application. In Figure 33, the consumer side of the heat exchanger has constant flow with the consumer-side design supply temperature of 5.6°C. The PHE has been sized such that, at 100% of design load, the district cooling return temperature is 12.2°C; thus, at maximum load the Δt is 7.7 K, assuming a 1.1 K approach. However, with constant flow on the consumer side at 50% of design load, over 83% of the peak design flow on the district cooling side is required and the district cooling return temperature has decreased to 9.8°C, thus lowering the Δt on the district cooling side to 5.3 K.

Figure 34, also from Tredinnick (2007), shows the situation under identical conditions but with variable flow on the consumer side of the PHE. As before, with the consumer-side design supply temperature of 5.6°C and at 100% of design load, the PHE has been sized to yield a district cooling return temperature of 12.2°C; thus, at design conditions, the Δt is 7.7 K, again assuming 1.1 K approach. However, at 50% load with variable flow on the consumer's side, only 51% of the design flow is required on the district cooling side, and the return temperature actually increases to 13.3°C. Thus, under this load condition, the Δt for the DCS increases from 5.3 K with constant flow to 8.8 K for variable consumer-side flow.

Variable flow also saves electrical pump energy and aids in controlling comfort. These examples, as well as others [e.g., Perdue and Ansbro (1999)] should make clear the need for variable flow on the consumer side of a PHE in an indirect connection of district cooling.

Typical constant-flow systems are found in older buildings and may be converted to simulate a variable-flow system by blocking off the bypass line around the air handler heat exchanger coil three-way control valve. At low operating pressures, this potentially may convert a three-way bypass-type valve to a two-way modulating shutoff valve. Carefully analyze the valve actuator, because the shutoff requirements and control characteristics are totally different for a two-way valve than for a three-way valve. For more information on building conversion, see Skagestad and Mildenstein (2002).

In theory, a cooling coil should have higher return water temperature when partially loaded than at full load, because the coil is oversized for the duty and thus has closer approach temperatures. In many real systems, as the load increases, the return water temperature tends to rise, and under low loads, the supply water temperature rises. Consequently, process or critical humidity control systems may suffer when connected to a system where return water temperature control is used to achieve high temperature differentials. Other techniques, such as separately pumping each CHW coil, may be used where constant supply water temperatures are necessary year round.

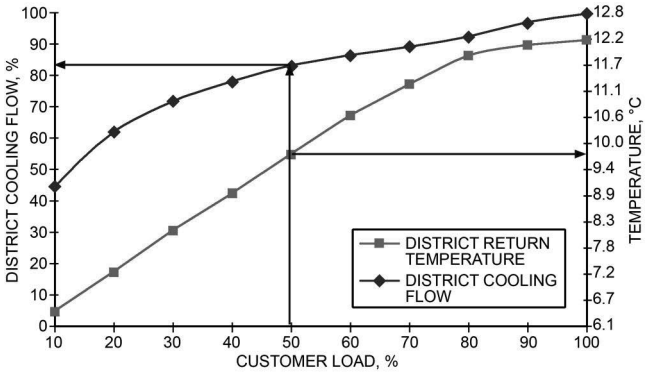


Fig. 33 Plate Heat-Exchanger Performance with Constant Flow on Customer Side and Customer-Side Supply Temperature of 5.6°C

(Tredinnick 2007)

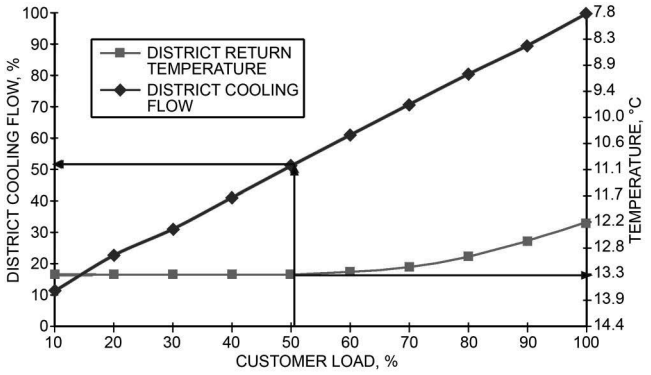


Fig. 34 Plate Heat-Exchanger Performance with Variable Flow on Customer Side and Customer-Side Supply Temperature of 5.6°C

(Tredinnick 2007)

Flow Control Devices

In commercial systems, after the flowmeter, control valves are the most important element in the interface with the district energy system because proper valve adjustment and calibration save energy. High-quality, industrial-grade control valves provide more precise control, longer service life, and minimum maintenance.

All control valve actuators should take longer than 60 s to close from full open to mitigate pressure transients or water hammer, which occurs when valves slam closed. Actuators should also be sized to close against the anticipated system pressure so the valve seats are not forced open, thus forcing water to bypass and degrading temperature differential.

The wide range of flows and pressures expected makes selection of control valves difficult. Typically, only one control valve is required; however, for optimal response to load fluctuations and to prevent cavitation, two valves in parallel are often needed. The two valves operate in sequence and for a portion of the load (i.e., one valve is sized for two-thirds of peak flow and the other sized for one-third of peak flow). The designer should review the occurrence of these loads to size the proportions correctly. The possibility of overstating customer loads complicates the selection process, so accurate load information is important. It is also important that the valve selected operates under the extreme pressure and flow ranges foreseen. Because most commercial-grade valves will not perform well for this installation, industrial-quality valves are typically specified.

Electronic control valves should remain in a fixed position when a power failure occurs and should be manually operable. Pneumatic control valves should close upon loss of air pressure. A manual override on the control valves allows the operator to control flow. All chilled-water control valves must fail in the closed position. Then, when any secondary in-building systems are deenergized, the valves close and will not bypass chilled water to the return system. All steam pressure-reducing valves should close as well.

Oversizing results in reduced valve and actuator life span and causes hunting. Select control valves having a wide range of control; low leakage; and proportional-plus-integral control for close adjustment, balancing, temperature accuracy, and response time. Control valves should have actuators with enough force to open and close under the maximum pressure differential in the system. The control valve should have a pressure drop through the valve equal to at least 10 to 30% of the static pressure drop of the distribution system. This pressure drop gives the control valve the "authority" it requires to properly control flow. The relationship between valve travel and capacity output should be linear, with an equal percentage characteristic.

Table 14 Measuring Points and Derivative Parameters for Remote Monitoring and Control of Indirect Consumer Interconnection

Measured Point/ Parameter	Location	
	District Cooling Side	Consumer Side
Temperature	Supply, return	Supply, return
Pressure	Supply, return	Supply, return
Differential pressure	At building entrance, heat exchanger(s), control valve(s), strainer	Heat exchanger(s)
Flow rate	Supply or return	
Energy transfer	Supply and return	
Position of control valve(s)	Yes	Optional
Variable-speed drive percentage(s)	Yes (not typical)	Yes

Table 15 Flowmeter Characteristics

Meter Type	Accuracy	Range of Control	Pressure Loss	Straight Piping Requirements (Length in Pipe Diameters)
Orifice plate	±1% to 5% full scale	3:1 to 5:1	High (>35 kPa)	10*D* to 40*D* upstream; 2*D* to 6*D* downstream
Electromagnetic	±0.15% to 1% rate	30:1 to 100:1	Low (<20 kPa)	5*D* to 10*D* upstream; 3*D* downstream
Vortex	±0.5% to 1.25% rate	10:1 to 25:1	Medium (20 to 35 kPa)	10*D* to 40*D* upstream; 2*D* to 6*D* downstream
Turbine	±0.15% to 0.5% rate	10:1 to 50:1	Medium (20 to 35 kPa)	10*D* to 40*D* upstream; 2*D* to 6*D* downstream
Ultrasonic	±1% to 5% rate	>10:1 to 100:1	Low (<20 kPa)	10*D* to 40*D* upstream; 2*D* to 6*D* downstream

In hot-water systems, control valves are normally installed in the return line because the lower temperature in the line reduces the risk of cavitation and increases valve life. In chilled-water systems, control valves can be installed in either location; typically, however, they are installed the return line to reduce the potential for condensation on exposed external surfaces and to minimize water turbulence upstream of the flowmeter.

Instrumentation

In many systems, where energy to the consumer is measured for billing purposes, temperature sensors assist in calculating the energy consumed as well as in diagnosing performance. Sensors and their transmitters should have an accuracy range commensurate to the accuracy of the flowmeter. In addition, pressure sensors are required for variable-speed pump control (water systems) or valve control for pressure-reducing stations (steam and water). Detailed recommendations on pressure, temperature, flow, and power transducers may be found in IDEA (2008a).

Temperature sensors need to be located by the exchangers being controlled rather than in the common pipe. Improperly located sensors cause one control valve to open and others to close, resulting in unequal loads in the exchangers. Temperature sensors used in energy metering applications should be matched-pair, four-wire, 1000 Ω for increased accuracy. Table 15 lists common measuring points and derivative parameters for remote monitoring and control of an indirect consumer interconnection. Other measuring points and derivative parameters may be required or recommended if the district heating utility assumes some responsibility for operation of the building system or if the building and district cooling system belong to a single owner.

Aside from the customary mechanical pressure gages that should be provided at the end-user interface for on-site diagnostics, pressure transducers are normally provided for remote monitoring and (often) control. Pressure transducers should be specified to provide accuracy of ±1% of full scale and typically resolution of 0.7 kPa (IDEA 2008a).

Controller

The controller performs several functions, including recording demand and the amount of energy used for billing purposes, monitoring the differential pressure for plant pump control, energy calculations, alarming for parameters outside normal, and monitoring and control of all components. Often, the controller has a small battery power supply to preserve settings and billing information.

Typical control strategies include regulating district flow to maintain the customer's supply temperature (which results in a fluctuating customer return temperature) or maintaining the customer's return temperature (which results in a fluctuating customer supply temperature). When controlling return flow for cooling, the effect on the customer's ability to dehumidify properly with an elevated entering coil temperature should be investigated carefully.

Pressure Control Devices

If the steam or water pressure delivered to the customer is too high for direct use, it must be reduced. Similarly, pressure-reducing or pressure-sustaining valves may be required if building height creates a high static pressure and influences the district system's return water pressure. Water pressure can also be reduced by control valves or regenerative turbine pumps. The risk of using pressure-regulating devices to lower pressure on the return line is that if they fail, the entire distribution system is exposed to their pressure, and overpressurization will occur.

In high-rise buildings, all piping, valves, coils, and other equipment may be required to withstand higher design pressures. Where system static pressure exceeds safe or economical operating pressure, either the heat exchanger method or pressure-sustaining valves in the return line may be used to minimize the effect of the pressure. Provide vacuum vents at the top of the building's water risers to introduce air into the piping in case the vertical water column collapses.

Flow and Energy Metering

All thermal energy or power delivered to customers or end users for billing or revenue by a commercially operated district energy system must be metered. The type of meter selected depends on the fluid to be measured, accuracy required, and expected turndown of flow to meet the low-flow and maximum-flow conditions. It is important that the meter be sized accurately for the anticipated loads and not oversized, because this will lead to inaccuracies. Historical, metered, or benchmarked data should be used when available if the actual load is not accurately known.

Steam may be used for direct comfort heating or to power absorption chillers for cooling. It is typically measured by using the differential pressure across calibrated orifices, nozzles, or venturi tubes; or by pitot tubes, vortex-shedding meters, or condensate meters. The mass flow can be converted to heat equivalent by assuming 2300 kJ/kg, but for more precise thermal metering, the meters are coupled with steam quality (temperature and pressure) differential heat content measuring devices. Care must be taken to deliver dry steam (superheated or saturated without free water) to the customer. Dry steam is delivered by installing an adequate trap just ahead of the customer's meter (or ahead of the customer's process when condensate meters are used).

When condensate meters are used, care must be taken to ensure that all condensate from the customer's process, but *only* such condensate, goes to the condensate meter. This may not be possible if the steam is used directly for humidification purposes and hence no condensate is returned. In this case, steam meters are preferable.

IDHA (1969) and Stultz and Kitto (1992) have more information on steam metering. For steam, as with hot- and chilled-water system metering, electronic and computer technology provide direct, integrating, and remote input to central control/measurement energy management systems.

Hot- and chilled-water systems are metered by measuring the temperature differential between the supply and return lines and the flow rate of the energy transfer medium. Thermal (kWh_{th}) meters compensate for the actual volume and heat content characteristics of the energy transfer medium. Thermal transducers, resistance thermometer elements, or liquid expansion capillaries are usually used to measure the differential temperature of the energy transfer medium in supply and return lines.

Water flow can be measured with a variety of meters, usually pressure differential, turbine or propeller, or displacement meters. Chapter 36 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, the *District Heating Handbook* (IDHA 1983), and Pomroy (1994) have more information on measurement. Ultrasonic meters are sometimes used to check performance of installed meters. Various flowmeters are available for district energy billing purposes. Critical characteristics for proper installation include clearances and spatial limitations as well as the attributes presented in Table 16. The data in the table only provide general guidance; meter manufacturers should be contacted for data specific to their products.

The meter should be located upstream of the heat exchanger and the control valve(s) should be downstream from the heat exchanger. This orientation minimizes the possible formation of bubbles in the flow stream and provide a more accurate flow indication. The transmitter should be calibrated for zero and span as recommended by the manufacturer.

Wherever possible, the type and size of meters selected should be standardized to reduce the number of stored spare parts, technician training, etc.

Displacement meters are more accurate than propeller meters, but they are also larger. They can handle flow ranges from less than 2% up to 100% of the maximum rated flow with claimed ±1% accuracy. Turbine-type meters require the smallest physical space for a given maximum flow. However, like many meters, they require at least 10 diameters of straight pipe upstream and downstream of the meter to achieve their claimed accuracy.

The United States has no performance standards for thermal meters. ASHRAE *Standard* 125 describes a test method for rating liquid thermal meters. Several European countries have developed performance standards and/or test methods for thermal meters, and CEN *Standard* EN 1434, developed by the European Community, is a performance and testing standard for heat meters.

District energy plant meters intended for billing or revenue require means for verifying performance periodically. Major meter manufacturers, some laboratories, and some district energy companies maintain facilities for this purpose. In the absence of a single performance standard, meters are typically tested in accordance with their respective manufacturers' recommendations. Primary measurement elements used in these laboratories frequently obtain calibration traceability to the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST).

For district energy cogeneration systems that send out and/or accept electric power to or from a utility grid, demand and usage meters must meet the existing utility requirements. For district energy systems that send out electric power directly to customers, the electric demand and usage meters must comply with local and state regulations. American National Standards Institute (ANSI) standards are established for all customary electric meters.

4.5 TEMPERATURE DIFFERENTIAL CONTROL

Maintaining a high water system temperature differential Δt between supply and return lines is most cost effective because it allows smaller pipes to be used in the primary distribution system. These savings must be weighed against higher building conversion costs that may result from the need for a low primary return temperature.

For district heating and cooling providers, hydronic system efficiency is usually measured in terms of the temperature differential. Proper control of the district heating and cooling temperature differential is not dictated at the plant but at the consumer. If the consumer's system is not compatible with the temperature parameters of the DHC system, operating efficiency suffers unless components in the consumer's system are modified. Low system Δt requires additional equipment to be energized, thus using more energy to satisfy the flow needs than the actual load demand requires. Therefore, the customer's Δt must be monitored and controlled.

To optimize the Δt, meet the customer's chilled-water demand, and save pump energy, flow from the plant should vary. Chilled-water flow in the customer's side must be varied as well. Terminal units in the building connected to the chilled-water loop (e.g., air-handling units, fan-coils) may require modifications (change three-way valves to two-way, etc.) to operate with variable water flow to ensure a maximum return water temperature.

For cooling coils, six-row with 1.8 to 2.1 mm fin spacing are the minimum size coil applied to central station air-handling units to provide adequate performance. With this type of coil, the return water temperature rise should range from 7 to 9 K at full load. Coil performance at reduced loads should be considered, as well; therefore, fluid velocity in the tube should remain high to stay in the turbulent flow range. To maintain a reasonable temperature differential at design conditions, fan-coil units are sized for an entering water temperature several degrees above the main chilled-water plant supply temperature. In theory, a cooling coil should have higher return water temperature when partially loaded than at full load because the coil is oversized for the duty and hence has closer approach temperatures.

The system designer must consider the aspect of return water temperature control, especially on chilled-water systems where the Δt is smaller than heating systems, so only a degree or two has a huge effect on system performance. Obtaining high temperature differentials is the single most important factor in operating an efficient plant. Active return water control requires adding a modulating control valve that closes if the temperature returns from the customer coils below the set point for cooling or above the set point for heating. Typically, these valves are industrial-grade ball valves because of their turndown and leaktight characteristics. Butterfly valves should not be used for this function.

Figure 26 shows the proper location of the Δt control valve; it is controlled from the customer return water temperature. If the water comes back too cool, the valve closes to achieve a higher return water temperature back to the plant. Although experience shows that this may increase the part-load system Δt by 0.5 to 1 K, it does come with risks. If the customer's building loop supply water temperature is not monitored, there is a risk that the temperature will become too high to adequately cool or dehumidify; hence, this secondary control feature is typically added to set an upper limit. In addition, the customer's cooling coil control valves may be polled by the building automation system (BAS). If a certain percentage of cooling control valves are wide open and the leaving air temperature on the air-handling unit is too high, the Δt control valve allows more cold water from the plant to enter the building.

4.6 OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE

As with any major capital equipment, care must be exercised in operating and maintaining district heating and cooling systems. Both central plant equipment and terminal equipment located in the consumer's building must be operated within intended parameters and maintained on a schedule as recommended by the manufacturer. Thermal distribution systems, especially buried systems, which are out of sight, may suffer from inadequate maintenance. To maintain the distribution system's thermal efficiency as well as its reliability,

integrity, and service life, periodic preventative maintenance is strongly recommended. In the case of steam and hot-water distribution systems, it may also be a matter of due diligence on the part of the owner/operator to ensure system integrity, to avoid thermal damage to adjacent property or harm to individuals coming in contact with the system or its thermal effects. Establishing an adequate preventive maintenance program for the distribution system requires consulting the system manufacturer's recommendations (where applicable) as well as considering the type, age, and condition of the system and its operating environment. See Phetteplace et al. (2013a, 2013b) for additional information on operation and maintenance for district cooling and heating systems, respectively.

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CHAPTER 13

HYDRONIC HEATING AND COOLING

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WATER systems that convey heat to or from a conditioned space or process with hot or chilled water are frequently called *hydronic systems*. Water flows through piping that connects a boiler, water heater, or chiller to suitable terminal heat transfer units located at the space or process.

Water systems can be classified by (1) operating temperature, (2) flow generation, (3) pressurization, (4) piping arrangement, and (5) pumping arrangement.

Classified by flow generation, hydronic heating systems may be (1) **gravity systems**, which use the difference in density between the supply and return water columns of a circuit or system to circulate water; or (2) **forced systems**, in which a pump, usually driven by an electric motor, maintains flow. Gravity systems are seldom used today and are therefore not discussed in this chapter. See the *ASHVE Heating Ventilating Air Conditioning Guide* issued before 1957 for information on gravity systems.

Water systems can be either once-through or recirculating systems. This chapter describes forced recirculating systems.

Successful water system design depends on awareness of the many complex interrelationships between various elements. In a practical sense, no component can be selected without considering its effect on the other elements. For example, design water temperature and flow rates are interrelated, as are the system layout and pump selection. The type and control of heat exchangers used affect the flow rate and pump selection, and the pump selection and distribution affect the controllability. The designer must thus work back and forth between tentative points and their effects until a satisfactory integrated design has been reached. Because of these relationships, rules of thumb usually do not lead to a satisfactory design.

Principles

Effective and economical water system design is affected by complex relationships between the various system components. The design water temperature, flow rate, piping layout, pump selection, terminal unit selection, and control method are all interrelated. System size and complexity determine the importance of these relationships to the total system operating success. In the United States, present hydronic heating system design practice originated in residential heating applications, where a temperature drop Δt of 11 K was used to determine flow rate. However, almost universal use of hydronic systems for both heating and cooling of large buildings and building complexes has rendered this simplified approach obsolete.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.1, Hydronic and Steam Equipment and Systems.

1. TEMPERATURE CLASSIFICATIONS

Water systems can be classified by operating temperature as follows.

Low-temperature water (LTW) systems operate within the pressure and temperature limits of the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* for low-pressure boilers. The maximum allowable working pressure for low-pressure boilers is 1100 kPa (gage), with a maximum temperature of 120°C. The usual maximum working pressure for boilers for LTW systems is 200 kPa, although boilers specifically designed, tested, and stamped for higher pressures are frequently used. Steam-to-water or water-to-water heat exchangers are also used for heating low-temperature water. LTW systems are used in buildings ranging from small, single dwellings to very large and complex structures.

Medium-temperature water (MTW) systems operate between 120 and 175°C, with pressures not exceeding 1100 kPa. The usual design supply temperature is approximately 120 to 160°C, with a usual pressure rating of 1 MPa for boilers and equipment.

High-temperature water (HTW) systems operate at temperatures over 175°C and usual pressures of about 2 MPa. The maximum design supply water temperature is usually about 200°C, with a pressure rating for boilers and equipment of about 2 MPa. The pressure-temperature rating of each component must be checked against the system's design characteristics.

Chilled-water (CW) systems for cooling normally operate with a design supply water temperature of 2 to 16°C and at a pressure of up to 830 kPa. Antifreeze or brine solutions may be used for applications (usually process applications) that require temperatures below 2°C or for coil freeze protection. Although not common, some equipment allows water temperatures down to 1°C without antifreeze; however, additional measures must be taken to ensure the water does not freeze. Well-water systems can use supply temperatures of 15°C or higher.

Dual-temperature water (DTW) systems combine heating and cooling, and circulate hot and/or chilled water through common piping and terminal heat transfer apparatus. These systems operate within the pressure and temperature limits of LTW systems, with usual winter design supply water temperatures of about 38 to 65°C and summer supply water temperatures of 4 to 7°C.

Some chilled-water systems use dual-temperatures; temperatures of 4 to 5°C are used for dedicated outdoor air units that dehumidify ventilation air. Sensible-only terminal cooling units use temperatures of 14 to 17°C to avoid unwanted condensation.

Terminal heat transfer units include convectors, cast-iron radiators, baseboard and commercial finned-tube units, fan-coil units, unit heaters, unit ventilators, central station air-handling units, radiant panels, induction units, chilled beams, hybrid sensible terminal

units, and snow-melting panels. A large storage tank may be included in the system to store energy for use when heat input devices such as the boiler or a solar energy collector are not supplying energy.

This chapter covers the principles and procedures for designing and selecting piping and components for low-temperature water, chilled water, and dual-temperature water systems. See Chapter 14 for information on medium- and high-temperature water systems.

2. CLOSED WATER SYSTEMS

Because most hot- and chilled-water systems are closed, this chapter addresses only closed systems. The fundamental difference between a closed and an open water system is the interface of the water with a compressible gas (such as air) or an elastic surface (such as a diaphragm). A **closed water system** is defined as one with no more than one point of interface with a compressible gas or surface, and that will not create system flow by changes in elevation. This definition is fundamental to understanding the hydraulic dynamics of these systems. Earlier literature referred to a system with an open or vented expansion tank as an "open" system, but this is actually a closed system; the atmospheric interface of the tank simply establishes the system pressure.

An **open system**, on the other hand, has more than one such interface. For example, a cooling tower system has at least two points of interface: the tower basin and the discharge pipe or nozzles entering the tower. One major difference in hydraulics between open and closed systems is that some hydraulic characteristics of open systems cannot occur in closed systems. For example, in contrast to the hydraulics of an open system, in a closed system (1) flow cannot be motivated by static pressure differences, (2) pumps do not provide static lift, and (3) the entire piping system is always filled with water.

Figure 1 shows the fundamental components of a closed hydronic system. Actual systems generally have additional components such as valves, vents, regulators, etc., but these are not essential to the basic principles underlying the system.

These fundamental components are

- Loads
- Source
- Expansion chamber
- Pump
- Distribution system

Theoretically, a hydronic system could operate with only these five components.

The components are subdivided into two groups: thermal and hydraulic. Thermal components consist of the load, source, and expansion chamber. Hydraulic components consist of the distribution system, pump, and expansion chamber. The expansion chamber is the only component that serves both a thermal and a hydraulic function.

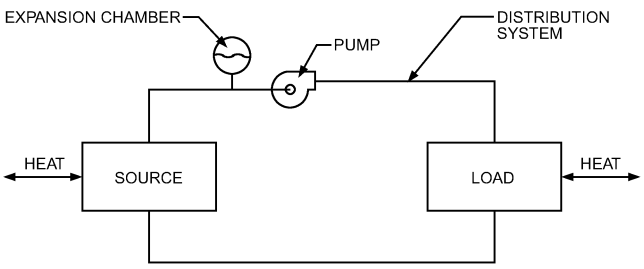

Fig. 1 Fundamental Components of Hydronic System

2.1 METHOD OF DESIGN

This section outlines general steps a designer may follow to complete system design. The methodology is not a rigid framework, but rather a flexible outline that should be adapted by the designer to suit current needs. The general order as shown is approximately chronological, but note that succeeding steps often affect preceding steps, so a fundamental reading of this entire chapter is required to fully understand the design process.

1. **Determine system and zone loads.** Loads are covered in Chapters 14 to 19 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Several load calculation procedures have been developed, with varying degrees of calculation accuracy. The load, in conjunction with design water temperature difference, determines the flow of the hydronic system, which ultimately affects the system's heat transfer ability and energy performance. Designers should apply the latest computerized calculation methods for optimal system design. Load calculation should also detail the facility's loading profile facility to enhance the hydronic system control strategy.
2. **Select comfort or process heat transfer devices.** This often means a coil- or water-to-air heat exchanger (terminal). Coil selection and operation has the single largest influence on hydronic system design. Coils implement the design criteria of flow, temperature difference, and control ability. Coil pressure loss and location affects pipe design and sizing, control devices, and pump selection. For details on coils, see Chapters 23 and 27.
3. **Select system distribution style(s).** Based on the load and its location, different piping styles may be appropriate for a given design. Styles may be comingled in a successful hydronic system design to optimize building performance. Schematically lay out the system to establish a preliminary design.
4. **Size branch piping system.** Based on the selection of the coil, its controlling devices, style of installation, and location, branch piping is sized to provide required flow, and pressure loss is calculated.
5. **Calculate distribution piping pressure loss.** Although the criteria for pipe selection in branch and distribution system piping may be similar, understanding the relationship and effect of distribution system pressure loss is important in establishing that all terminals get the required flow for the required heat transfer.
6. **Lay out piping system and size pipes.** After preliminary calculations of target friction loss for the pipes, sketch the system. After the piping system is laid out and the calculations of actual design pressure loss are complete, note the losses on the drawings for the commissioning process.
7. **Select pump specialties.** Any devices required for operation or measurement are identified, so their pressure loss can be determined and accounted for in pump selection.
8. **Select air management methodology.** All hydronic systems entrain air in the circulated fluid. Managing the collection of that air as it leaves the working fluid is essential to management of system pressure and the safe operation of system components.
9. **Select pump (hydraulic components).** Unless a system is very small (e.g., a residential hot-water heating system), the pump is selected to fit the system. A significant portion of energy use in a hydronic system is transporting the fluid through the distribution system. Proper pump selection limits this energy use, whereas improper selection leads to energy inefficiency and poor distribution and heat transfer.
10. **Determine installation details, iterate design.** Tuning the design to increase performance and cost effectiveness is an important last step. Documenting installation details is also important, because this communication is necessary for well-built designs and properly operated systems.

2.2 THERMAL COMPONENTS

Loads

The load is the impetus that causes heat to flow out of or into the system to or from the space or process; it is the independent variable to which the remainder of the system must respond. Outward heat flow characterizes a heating system, and inward heat flow characterizes a cooling system. The quantity of heating or cooling is calculated by one of the following means.

Sensible Heating or Cooling. The rate of heat entering or leaving an airstream is expressed as follows:

$$q = Q_a \rho_a c_p \Delta t \quad (1)$$

where

q = heat transfer rate to or from air, W
Q_a = airflow rate, L/s
ρ_a = density of air, kg/m^3
c_p = specific heat of air, kJ/(kg·K)
Δt = temperature increase or decrease of air, K

For standard air with a density of 1.20 kg/m^3 and a specific heat of 1.0 kJ/(kg·K), Equation (1) becomes

$$q = 1.20 Q_a \Delta t \quad (2)$$

The heat exchanger or coil must then transfer this heat from or to the water. The rate of sensible heat transfer to or from the heated or cooled medium in a specific heat exchanger is a function of the heat transfer surface area; the mean temperature difference between the water and the medium; and the overall heat transfer coefficient, which itself is a function of the fluid velocities, properties of the medium, geometry of the heat transfer surfaces, and other factors. The rate of heat transfer may be expressed by

$$q = UA(\text{LMTD}) \quad (3)$$

where

q = heat transfer rate through heat exchanger, W
U = overall coefficient of heat transfer, W/(m^2·K)
A = heat transfer surface area, m^2
LMTD = logarithmic mean temperature difference, heated or cooled medium to water, K

Cooling and Dehumidification. The rate of heat removal from the cooled medium when both sensible cooling and dehumidification are present is expressed by

$$q_t = 1000 w \Delta h \quad (4)$$

where

q_t = total heat transfer rate from cooled medium, W
w = mass flow rate of cooled medium, kg/s
Δh = enthalpy difference between entering and leaving conditions of cooled medium, kJ/kg

Expressed for an air-cooling coil, this equation becomes

$$q_t = Q_a \rho_a \Delta h \quad (5)$$

which, for standard air with a density of 1.20 kg/m^3, reduces to

$$q_t = 1.20 Q_a \Delta h \quad (6)$$

Heat Transferred to or from Water. The rate of heat transfer to or from the water is a function of the flow rate, specific heat, and temperature rise or drop of the water as it passes through the heat exchanger. The heat transferred to or from the water is expressed by

$$q_w = 1000 \dot{m} c_p \Delta t \quad (7)$$

where

q_w = heat transfer rate to or from water, W
$\dot{m}$ = mass flow rate of water, kg/s
c_p = specific heat of water, kJ/(kg·K)
Δt = water temperature increase or decrease across unit, K

With water systems, it is common to express the flow rate as volumetric flow, in which case Equation (7) becomes

$$q_w = \rho_w c_p Q_w \Delta t \quad (8)$$

where

Q_w = water flow rate, L/s
ρ_w = density of water, kg/m^3

For standard conditions in which the density is 1000 kg/m^3 and the specific heat is 4.18 kJ/(kg·K), Equation (8) becomes

$$q_w = 4180 Q_w \Delta t \quad (9)$$

Equation (8) or (9) can be used to express the heat transfer across a single load or source device, or any quantity of such devices connected across a piping system. In the design or diagnosis of a system, the load side may be balanced with the source side using these equations.

Heat-Carrying Capacity of Piping. Equations (8) and (9) are also used to express the heat-carrying capacity of the piping or distribution system or any portion thereof. The existing temperature differential Δt, sometimes called the temperature range, is identified; for any flow rate Q_w through the piping, q_w is called the **heat-carrying capacity**.

Load Devices

Many types of load devices are used in central water systems, and may be classified in several different ways:

- **Natural convection units** include cabinet convectors, baseboard, and finned-tube radiation. Older systems may have cast-iron radiators, which are sometimes sought out for architectural restoration.
- **Forced-convection units** include unit heaters, unit ventilators, fan-coil units, air-handling units, heating and cooling coils in central station units, and most process heat exchangers. Fan-coil units, unit ventilators, and central station units can be used for heating, ventilating, and cooling.
- **Induction units** include active chilled beams that use a central airstream to induce airflow across terminal coils.
- **Radiation units** include panel systems, unit radiant panels, in-floor or wall piping systems, passive chilled beams, and some older styles of radiators. All transfer some convective heat. These units are generally used in low-temperature water systems, with lower design temperatures. Similarly, chilled panels are also used for sensible cooling and in conjunction with central station air-handling units isolating outdoor air conditioning.

Load devices must be selected for sufficient capacity to match the calculated heating and cooling loads. Manufacturers' ratings should be used with reference to actual operating conditions. Ratings are either computer selected, or cataloged by water temperature, temperature drop or rise, entering air temperatures, water velocity, and airflow. Ratings are usually given for standard test conditions with correction factors or curves, and rating tables are given covering a range of operating conditions. Because the choice of terminal units for any particular building or type of system is so wide, the designer must carefully consider the advantages and disadvantages of the various alternatives so the end result is maximum comfort and economy.

Most **load devices** (in which heat is conveyed to or from the water for heating or cooling the space or process) are a water-to-air finned-coil heat exchanger or a water-to-water exchanger. The specific configuration is usually used to describe the load device. The most common configurations include the following:

Heating load devices
- Preheat coils in central units
- Heating coils in central units
- Zone or central reheat coils
- Finned-tube radiators
- Baseboard radiators
- Convectors
- Unit heaters
- Fan-coil units
- Unit ventilators
- Water-to-water heat exchangers
- Radiant heating panels
- Snow-melting panels

Cooling load devices
- Coils in central units
- Fan-coil units
- Unit ventilators
- Induction unit coils (similar to chilled beams)
- Radiant cooling panels
- Water-to-water heat exchangers

Source

The source is the point where heat is added to (heating) or removed from (cooling) the system. Ideally, the amount of energy entering or leaving the source equals the amount entering or leaving through the load. Under steady-state conditions, the load energy and source energy are equal and opposite. Also, when properly measured or calculated, the products of the temperature differentials and flow rates across the source and loads are equal. Equations (8) and (9) express the source capacities as well as the load capacities.

Any device that can be used to heat or cool water under controlled conditions can be used as a source device. The most common source devices for heating and cooling systems are the following:

Heating source devices
- Hot-water generator or boiler
- Steam-to-water heat exchanger
- Water-to-water heat exchanger
- Solar heating panels
- Heat recovery or salvage heat device (e.g., water jacket of an internal combustion engine)
- Exhaust gas heat exchanger
- Incinerator heat exchanger
- Heat pump or heat recovery condenser
- Air-to-water heat exchanger

Cooling source devices
- Electric compression chiller
- Thermal absorption chiller
- Heat pump evaporator
- Air-to-water heat exchanger
- Water-to-water heat exchanger

The two primary considerations in selecting a source device are the design capacity and the part-load capability, sometimes called the **turndown ratio**. The turndown ratio, expressed in percent of design capacity, is

$$\text{Turndown ratio} = 100\frac{\text{Minimum capacity}}{\text{Design capacity}} \tag{10}$$

The reciprocal of the turndown ratio is sometimes used (e.g., a turndown ratio of 25% may also be expressed as a turndown ratio of 4).

The turndown ratio has a significant effect on system performance; lack of consideration of the source system's part-load capability has been responsible for many systems that either do not function properly or do so at the expense of excess energy consumption. The turndown ratio has a significant effect on the ultimate equipment and/or system design selection.

Note that the turndown ratio for a source is different from that specified for a control valve. **Rangeability** is the relationship of the maximum flow to the minimum flow based on laboratory testing of the valve body alone. **Turndown** is the relationship of the valve assembly's (valve + actuator + linkage) maximum usable flow to the minimum controllable flow installed in a system.

System Temperatures. Design temperatures and temperature ranges are selected by consideration of the performance requirements and the economics of the components. The return water temperature is limited to the entering air temperature minus the coil approach temperature. The lowest practical supply water temperature for refrigeration, considering the freezing point of water and economics, is about 2°C, although some chillers today supply water (without antifreeze) at 1°C. This temperature spread then sets constraints for a chilled-water system.

Pedersen et al. (1998) describe a classic method for calculating the required temperature of chilled water from the psychrometric chart.

The entering water temperature follows the relationship

$$t_w = 2t_{ad} - t_{wb} \tag{11}$$

where

t_w = coil entering water temperature
t_{ad} = apparatus dew point
t_{wb} = coil leaving air wet-bulb temperature

The designer should note that there are also constraints imposed on the temperature and differential temperature selection by the chiller selection (e.g., refrigerant choice), and on the coil's flow tolerance with respect to heat transfer. Consult with the chiller manufacturer so that performance requirements of the chiller are taken into account.

For a heating system, the maximum hot-water temperature is normally established by the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* as 120°C, and with space temperature requirements of little above 24°C, the actual operating supply temperatures and temperature ranges are set by the design of the load devices. Most economic considerations relating to distribution and pumping systems favor using the maximum possible temperature range Δt.

Expansion Chamber

The expansion chamber (also called an **expansion** or **compression tank**) serves both a thermal and a hydraulic function. In its thermal function, the tank provides a space into which the noncompressible liquid can expand or from which it can contract as the liquid undergoes volumetric changes with changes in temperature. To allow for this expansion or contraction, the expansion tank provides an interface point between the system fluid and a compressible gas. By definition, a closed system can have only one such interface; thus, a system designed to function as a closed system can have only one expansion chamber.

Expansion tanks are of three basic configurations: (1) a closed tank, which contains a captured volume of compressed air and water, with an air/water interface (sometimes as simple as a plain steel tank); (2) an open tank (i.e., one open to the atmosphere); and (3) a diaphragm tank, in which a flexible membrane is inserted

between the air and the water (a modified version is the **bladder tank**).

Properly installed, a closed or diaphragm tank serves the purpose of system pressurization control with a minimum of exposure to air in the system. Open tanks, commonly used in older systems, tend to introduce air into the system, which can enhance piping corrosion. Open tanks are generally not recommended for application in current designs. Older-style steel compression tanks tend to be larger than diaphragm expansion tanks. In some cases, there may be economic considerations that make one tank preferable over another. These economics usually are relatively straightforward (e.g., initial cost), but there can be significant size differences, which affect placement and required building space and structural support, and these effects should also be considered.

Sizing the tank is the primary thermal consideration in incorporating a tank into a system. However, before sizing the tank, air control or elimination must be considered. The amount of air that will be absorbed and can be held in solution with the water is expressed by Henry's equation (Pompei 1981):

$$x = p/H \tag{12}$$

where

x = solubility of air in water (% by volume)
p = absolute pressure
H = Henry's constant

Henry's constant, however, is constant only for a given temperature (Figure 2). Combining the data of Figure 2 (Himmelblau 1960) with Equation (12) results in the solubility diagram of Figure 3. With that diagram, the solubility can be determined if the temperature and pressure are known.

If the water is not saturated with air, it will absorb air at the air/water interface until the point of saturation has been reached. Once absorbed, the air will move throughout the body of water either by mass migration or by molecular diffusion until the water is uniformly saturated. If the air/water solution changes to a state that reduces solubility, excess air will be released as a gas. For example, if the air/water interface is at high pressure, the water will absorb air to its limit of solubility at that point; if at another point in the system the pressure is reduced, some of the dissolved air will be released.

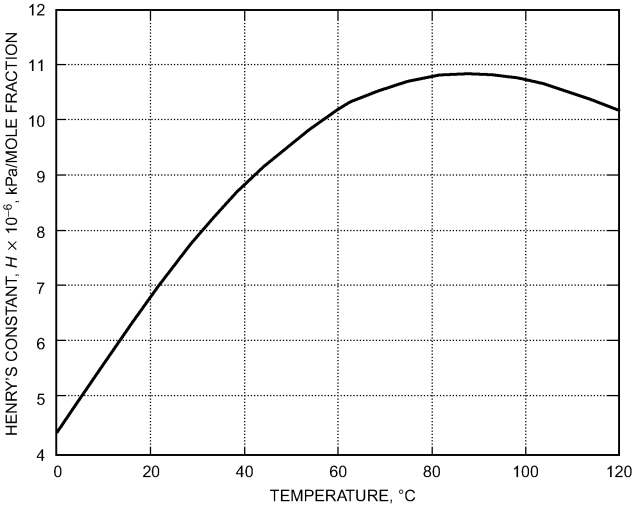

Fig. 2 Henry's Constant Versus Temperature for Air and Water

(Coad 1980a)

In the design of systems with open or plain steel expansion tanks, it is common practice to use the tank as the major air control or release point in the system.

Equations for sizing the three common configurations of expansion tanks follow (Coad 1980b):

For closed tanks with air/water interface

$$V_t = V_s \frac{[(v_2/v_1) - 1] - 3\alpha\,\Delta t}{(P_a/P_1) - (P_a/P_2)} \tag{13}$$

For open tanks with air/water interface

$$V_t = 2V_s\left[\left(\frac{v_2}{v_1} - 1\right) - 3\alpha\,\Delta t\right] \tag{14}$$

For diaphragm tanks

$$V_t = V_s \frac{[(v_2/v_1) - 1] - 3\alpha\Delta t}{1 - (P_1/P_2)} \tag{15}$$

where

V_t = volume of expansion tank, m^3
V_s = volume of water in system, m^3
t_1 = lower temperature, °C
t_2 = higher temperature, °C
P_a = atmospheric pressure, kPa
P_1 = pressure at lower temperature, kPa
P_2 = pressure at higher temperature, kPa
v_1 = specific volume of water at lower temperature, m^3/kg
v_2 = specific volume of water at higher temperature, m^3/kg
α = linear coefficient of thermal expansion, m/(m·K)
= 11.7×10^{-6} m/(m·K) for steel
= 17.1×10^{-6} m/(m·K) for copper
$\Delta t = (t_2 - t_1)$, K

As an example, the lower temperature for a heating system is usually normal ambient temperature at fill conditions (e.g., 10°C)

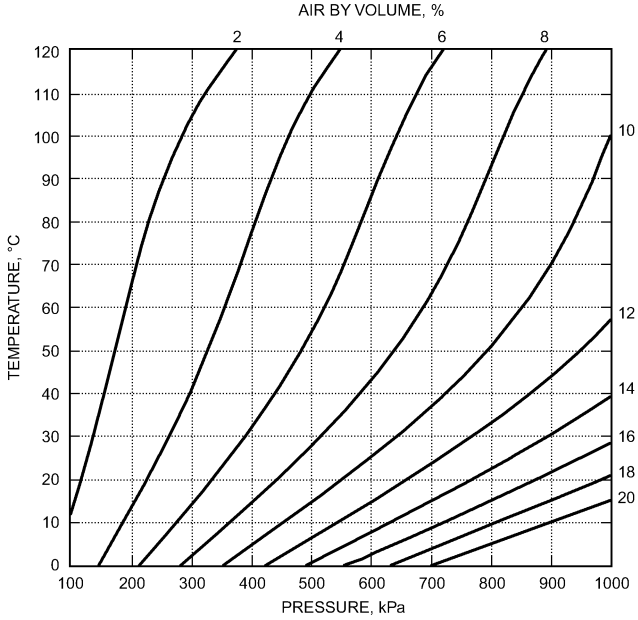

Fig. 3 Solubility Versus Temperature and Pressure for Air/Water Solutions

and the higher temperature is the operating supply water temperature for the system. For a chilled-water system, the lower temperature is the design chilled-water supply temperature, and the higher temperature is ambient temperature (e.g., 35°C). For a dual-temperature hot/chilled system, the lower temperature is the chilled-water design supply temperature, and the higher temperature is the heating water design supply temperature.

For specific volume and saturation pressure of water at various temperatures, see Table 3 in Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

At the tank connection point, the pressure in closed-tank systems increases as the water temperature increases. Pressures at the expansion tank are generally set by the following parameters:

- The lower pressure is usually selected to hold a positive pressure at the highest point in the system [usually about 70 kPa (gage)].
- The higher pressure is normally set by the maximum pressure allowable at the location of the safety relief valve(s) without opening them.

Other considerations are to ensure that (1) the pressure at no point in the system will ever drop below the saturation pressure at the operating system temperature and (2) all pumps have sufficient net positive suction pressure available to prevent cavitation.

Example 1. Size an expansion tank for a heating water system that will operate at a design temperature range of 80 to 104°C. The minimum pressure at the tank is 170 kPa and the maximum pressure is 270 kPa. (Atmospheric pressure is 101 kPa.) The volume of water is 10 m^3. The piping is steel.

1. Calculate the required size for a closed tank with an air/water interface.

Solution: For lower temperature t_1, use 4°C.

From Table 3 in Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*,

$$v_1(\text{at } 4°C) = 0.001000 \text{ m}^3/\text{kg}$$

$$v_2(\text{at } 104°C) = 0.001047 \text{ m}^3/\text{kg}$$

Using Equation (13),

$$V_t = 10 \times \frac{[(0.001047/0.001000) - 1] - 3(11.7 \times 10^{-6})(104 - 4)}{(101/170) - (101/270)}$$

$$V_t = 1.98 \text{ m}^3$$

2. If a diaphragm tank were used in lieu of the plain steel tank, what tank size would be required?

Solution: Using Equation (15),

$$V_t = 10 \times \frac{[(0.001047/0.001000) - 1] - 3(11.7 \times 10^{-6})(104 - 4)}{1 - (170/270)}$$

$$V_t = 1.17 \text{ m}^3$$

2.3 HYDRAULIC COMPONENTS

Pump or Pumping System

Centrifugal pumps are the most common type in hydronic systems (see Chapter 44). Circulating pumps used in water systems can vary in size from small in-line circulators delivering pressure to base-mounted or vertical pumps handling hundreds of litres per second, with pressures limited only by the system characteristics. Pump operating characteristics must be carefully matched to system operating requirements.

Pump Curves and Water Temperature for Constant-Speed Systems. Performance characteristics of centrifugal pumps are described by pump curves, which plot flow versus pressure, as well as by efficiency and power information, as shown in Figure 4.

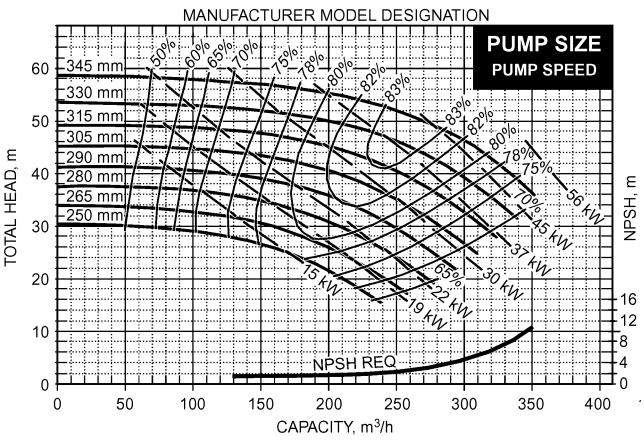

Fig. 4 Example of Manufacturer's Published Pump Curve

Large pumps tend to have a series of curves, designated with a numerical size in inches (i.e., 250 to 350 mm in diameter), to represent performance of the pump impeller and outline the envelope of pump operation. Intersecting elliptical lines designate the pump's efficiency. The **net positive suction pressure (NPSP)** required line represents the required entering operating pressure for the pump to operate satisfactorily. Diagonal lines represent the required power of the pump motor. The point at which a pump operates is the point at which the pump curve intersects the system curve (Figure 5).

In Figure 4, note that each performance curve has a defined end point. Small circulating pumps, which may exhibit a pump curve as shown in Figure 6, may actually extend to the abscissa showing a run-out flow, and may also not show multiple impellers, efficiency, or NPSH. Large pumps do not exhibit the run-out flow characteristic. In a large pump, the area to the right of the Figure 4 curve is an area of unsatisfactory performance, and may represent pump operation in a state of cavitation. It is important that the system curve always intersect the pump curve in operation, and the design must ensure that system operation stays on the pump curve.

Chapter 44 also discusses system and pump curves.

A complete piping system follows the same water flow/pressure drop relationships as any component of the system. Thus, the pressure required for any proposed flow rate through the system may be determined and a system curve constructed. A pump may be selected by using the calculated system pressure at the design flow rate as the base point value.

Figure 6 illustrates how a shift of the system curve to the right affects system flow rate. This shift can be caused by incorrectly cal-

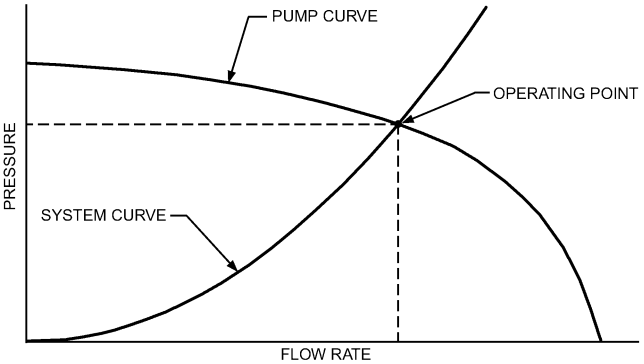

Fig. 5 Pump Curve and System Curve

culating the system pressure drop by using arbitrary safety factors or overstated pressure drop charts. Variable system flow caused by control valve operation, a larger than required control valve, or improperly balanced systems (subcircuits having substantially lower pressure drops than the longest circuit) can also cause a shift to the right.

As described in Chapter 44, pumps for closed-loop piping systems should have a flat pressure characteristic and should operate slightly to the left of the peak efficiency point on their curves. This allows the system curve to shift to the right without causing undesirable pump operation, overloading, or reduction in available pressure across circuits with large pressure drops.

Many dual-temperature systems are designed so that the chillers are bypassed during winter. The chiller pressure drop, which may be quite high, is thus eliminated from the system pressure drop, and the pump shift to the right may be quite large. For such systems, use system curve analysis to check winter operating points.

Operating points may be highly variable, depending on (1) load conditions, (2) the types of control valves used, and (3) the piping circuitry and heat transfer elements. In general, the best selection in smaller systems is

- For design flow rates calculated using pressure drop charts that illustrate actual closed-loop hydronic system piping pressure drops
- To the left of the maximum efficiency point of the pump curve to allow shifts to the right caused by system circuit unbalance, direct-return circuitry applications, and modulating three-way valve applications
- A pump with a flat curve to compensate for unbalanced circuitry and to provide a minimum pressure differential increase across two-way control valves

As system sizes and corresponding pump sizes increase in size, more care is needed in analysis of the pump selection. The Hydraulic Institute (HI 2000) offers a detailed discussion of pump operation and selection to optimize life cycle costs. The HI guide covers all types of pumping systems, including those that are much more sophisticated than a basic HVAC closed-loop circulating system, and use much more power. There are direct parallels, though. HI's discussion of pump reliability sensitivity includes a chart similar to that shown in Figure 7.

HVAC pumps tend to be low-energy devices compared to industrial or process pumps, which might be responsible for a wide variety of different fluids and operating conditions. Select a pump as close as possible to the best efficiency point, to optimize life-cycle costs and maximize operating life with a minimum of maintenance. HI's recommendations are also appropriate for HVAC pump selection.

Parallel Pumping. When pumps are applied in parallel, each pump operates at the same pressure, and provides its share of the system flow at that pressure (Figure 8). Generally, pumps of equal size are used, and the parallel-pump curve is established by doubling the flow of the single-pump curve (with identical pumps).

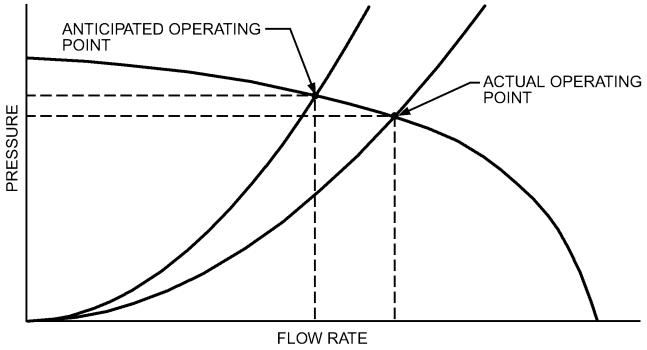

Fig. 6 Shift of System Curve Caused by Circuit Unbalance

Plotting a system curve across the parallel-pump curve shows the operating points for both single- and parallel-pump operation (Figure 8). Note that single-pump operation does not yield 50% flow. The system curve crosses the single-pump curve considerably to the right of its operating point when both pumps are running. This leads to two important concerns: (1) the pumps must be powered to prevent overloading during single-pump operation, and (2) a single pump can provide standby service of up to 80% of design flow; the actual amount depends on the specific pump curve and system curve. As pumps become larger, or more than two pumps are placed in parallel operation, it is still very important to ensure in the design that the operating system intersects the operating pump curve, and that there are safeties in place to ensure that, should a pump be turned off, the remaining pumps and system curve still intersect one another.

Series Pumping. When pumps are operated in series, each pump operates at the same flow rate and provides its share of the total pressure at that flow. A system curve plotted across the series-pump curve shows the operating points for both single- and series-pump operation (Figure 9). Note that the single pump can provide up to 80% flow for standby and at a lower power requirement.

Series-pump installations are often used in heating and cooling systems so that both pumps operate during the cooling season to provide maximum flow and pressure, whereas only a single pump operates during the heating season. Note that both parallel- and series-pump applications require that the actual pump operating points be used to accurately determine the pumping point. Adding pressure for safety, using improper pressure drop charts, or incorrectly calculating pressure drops may lead to an unwise selection.

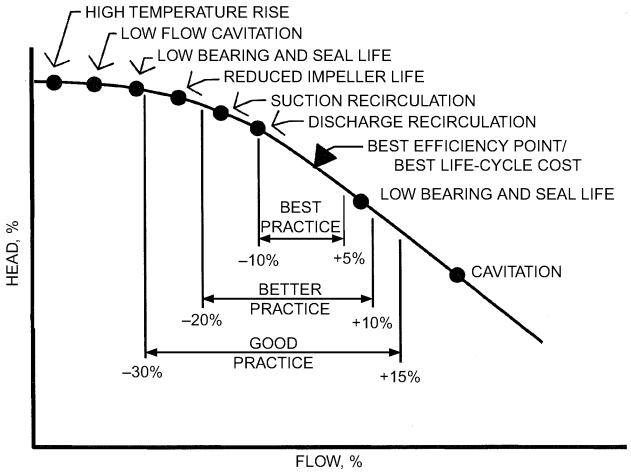

Fig. 7 General Pump Operating Condition Effects

(Hydraulic Institute)

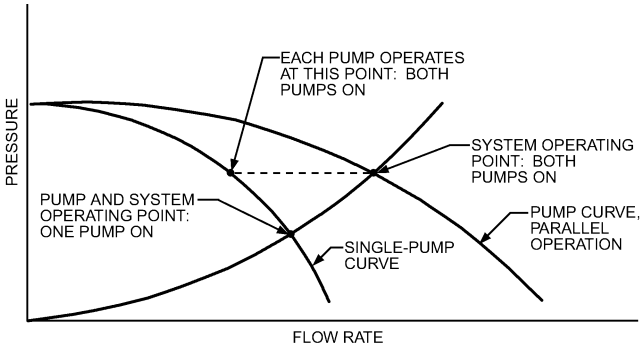

Fig. 8 Operating Conditions for Parallel-Pump Installation

Multiple-Pump Systems. Care must be taken in designing systems with multiple pumps to ensure that, if pumps ever operate in either parallel or series, such operation is fully understood and considered by the designer. Pumps performing unexpectedly in series or parallel have caused performance problems in hydronic systems, such as the following:

Parallel. With pumps of unequal pressures, one pump may create a pressure across the other pump in excess of its cutoff pressure, causing flow through the second pump to diminish significantly or to cease. This can cause flow problems or pump damage.

Series. With pumps of different flow capacities, the pump of greater capacity may overflow the pump of lesser capacity, which could cause damaging cavitation in the smaller pump and could actually cause a pressure drop rather than a pressure rise across that pump. In other circumstances, unexpected series operation can cause excessively high or low pressures that can damage system components.

Standby Pump Provision. If total flow standby capacity is required, a properly valved standby pump of equal capacity is installed to operate when the normal pump is inoperable. A single standby may be provided for several similarly sized pumps. Parallel- or series-pump installation can provide up to 80% standby, which is often sufficient.

Compound Pumping. In larger systems, compound pumping, also known as **primary/secondary pumping**, is often used to provide system advantages that would not be available with a single pumping system. Compound pumping is illustrated in Figure 10.

In Figure 10, pump 1 can be referred to as the **source** or **primary pump** and pump 2 as the **load** or **secondary pump**. The short section of pipe between A and B is called the **common pipe** (also called the **decoupling line** or **neutral bridge**) because it is common to both the source and load circuits. The term "decoupler" is used because the common pipe separates or decouples the working pressure of the source and load circuits. In the design of compound systems, keep the common pipe as short and as large in diameter as practical to minimize pressure loss between those two points. With that said, if the pipe is too large and too short it may become a "tank" and allow unwanted recirculation to the source or load. Carefully ensure adequate length in the common pipe to prevent recirculation from entry or exit turbulence. Often, the common pipe diameter is the same as the pipe diameter to the largest source (chiller or boiler) and approximately 10 pipe diameters long. If the common pipe is shorter, minimal pressure drop (to avoid recirculation) can be added by forming a "U" with two elbows between the supply and return piping manifolds. If a tank is used as the bypass, ensure that water cannot short circuit either way by using baffles or other means. There should never be a valve or check valve in the common pipe. If these conditions are met and the pressure loss in the common pipe can be assumed to be zero, then neither pump will affect the other. Then, except for the system static pressure at any given point, the circuits can be designed and analyzed and will function dynamically independently of one another.

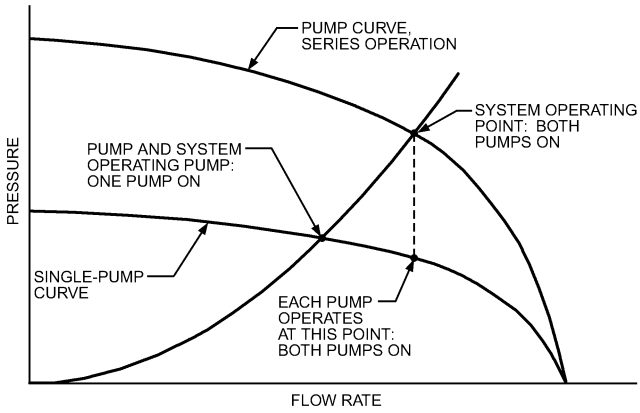

Fig. 9 Operating Conditions for Series-Pump Installation

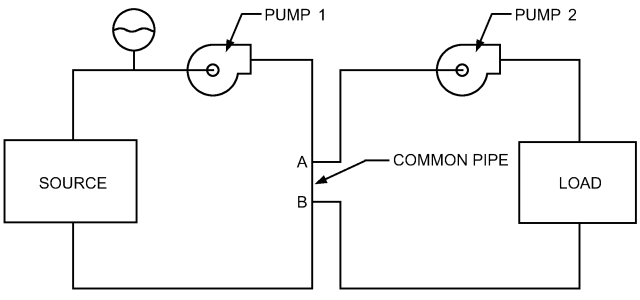

Fig. 10 Compound Pumping (Primary/Secondary Pumping)

In Figure 10, if pump 1 has the same flow capacity in its circuit as pump 2 has in its circuit, all of the flow entering point A from pump 1 will leave in the branch supplying pump 2, and no water will flow in the common pipe. Under this condition, the water entering the load will be at the same temperature as that leaving the source.

If the flow capacity of pump 1 exceeds that of pump 2, some water will flow downward in the common pipe. Under this condition, tee A is a diverting tee, and tee B becomes a mixing tee. Again, the temperature of the fluid entering the load is the same as that leaving the source. However, because of the mixing taking place at point B, the temperature of water returning to the source is between the source supply temperature and the load return temperature.

On the other hand, if the flow capacity of pump 1 is less than that of pump 2, then point A becomes a mixing point because some water must recirculate upward in the common pipe from point B. The temperature of the water entering the load is between the supply water temperature from the source and the return water temperature from the load.

For example, if pump 1 circulates 1.5 L/s of water leaving the source at 95°C, and pump 2 circulates 3 L/s of water leaving the load at 35°C, then the water temperature entering the load is

$$t_{load} = 95 - (1.5/3)(95 - 35) = 65°C \quad (16)$$

Mixing occurs in chilled-water systems with constant-speed pumping applied to the primary pump circuit of the source, and variable-speed pumping applied to the secondary system connected to the loads. The issues associated with this are generally source- and control-related. At one time, chiller manufacturers restricted water flow variation through a chiller, despite the fact that designers and system operators wanted this ability, to increase system energy operating economy and reduce operating costs by reducing flow. Mixing was an inevitable by-product. This situation was exacerbated when variable-speed drives were applied to pumps, while chiller pumps stayed constant speed. Today, changes to chiller controls often allow flow rate through the chiller evaporator to be varied. Some system designs have shifted away from compound pumping to variable-speed, variable-flow primary pumping to enhance system efficiency. Depending on locale, system size, and selection criteria for the chiller, compound pumping may still be beneficial to system design and operating stability. Chiller selections often are limited to maximum fluid velocities of 3.4 m/s, and minimum velocities of 0.46 or 0.61 m/s. Variable-speed pumping in both primary and secondary circuits can be applied to reduce mixing that might occur as chillers are sequenced on and off to compensate for the loads.

The following are some advantages of compound circuits:

- They allow different water temperatures and temperature ranges in different elements of the system. Compound pumping can be used to vary coil capacity by controlling leaving coil air temperature, which leads to better latent energy control.
- They decouple the circuits hydraulically, thereby simplifying the control, operation, and analysis of large systems. Hydraulic decoupling also prevents unwanted series or parallel operation of pumps. Large water circuits often experience pressure imbalances, but compound pumping allows a design to be hydraulically organized into separate smaller subsystems, making troubleshooting and operation easier.

Variable-Speed Pumping Application

Centrifugal pumps may also be operated with variable-frequency drives, which adjust the speed of the electric motor, changing the pump curve. In this application, a pump controller and typically one frequency drive per pump are applied to control the required system variable.

The most typical application is to control differential pressure across one or more branches of the piping network. In a common application, the differential pressure is sensed across a control valve or, alternatively, the valve, coil, and branch (Figure 11). The controller is given a set point equal to the pressure loss of the sensed components at design flow. For example, a 35 kPa differential pressure was used to size the control valve; the sensor is connected to sense differential pressure across the valve, so a 35 kPa set point is given to the controller. As the control valve closes in reaction to a control signal (Figure 12) from 1 to 2, the differential pressure across the branch rises as the system curve shifts counterclockwise up the pump curve. The pump controller, sensing an increase in differential, decreases the speed of the pump to about point 3, roughly 88% speed. Note that each system curve is shown with two representations. The system curve is the simple relationship of the flow ratio squared to the pressure ratio. Under control of a pump controller with a single sensor across the control valve, as shown in Figure 11, the pump decreases in speed until the theoretical zero-flow point, at which the pump goes just fast enough to maintain a differential pressure under no flow. In this case, the speed is about 88%, and the power is about 68%. In operation, expect there to be a difference in performance. Figure 12 shows the change as a step function, opposite of the way in which the pump controller functions. Based on the control method, the controller adjustment settings (gain, integral time, and derivative time), system hydraulics, valve time constant, sensor sensitivity, etc., it is far more likely that a small incremental rise in differential pressure will have a corresponding small decrease

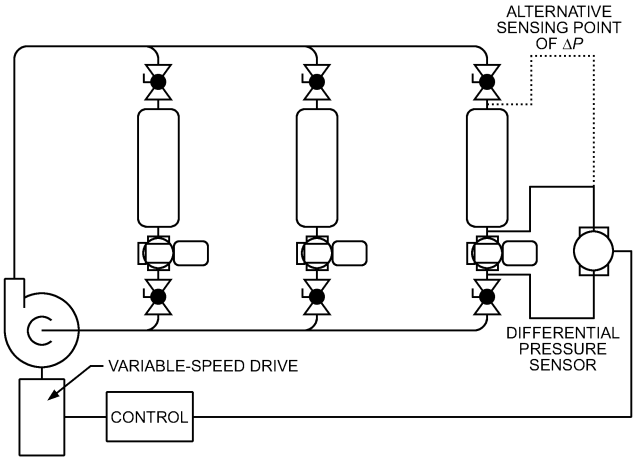

Fig. 11 Example of Variable-Speed Pump System Schematic

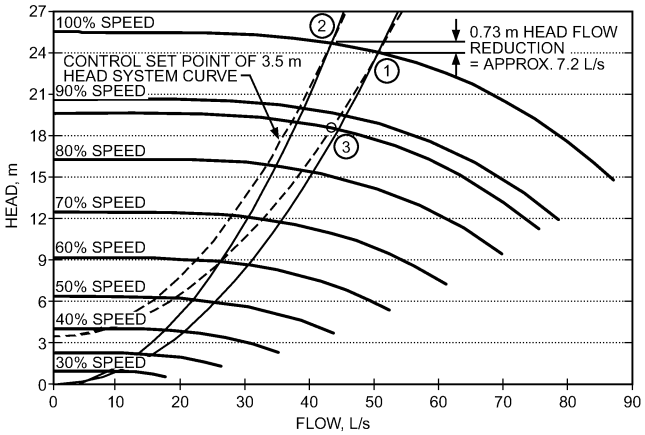

Fig. 12 Example of Variable-Speed Pump and System Curves

in pump speed, as the valve repositions itself in reaction to its control signal. This appears as a small sawtoothed series of system curve and pump curve intersection points, and is not of real importance. What is important is that many factors influence operation, and theoretical variable-speed pumping is different from reality.

Decreasing pump speed is analogous to using a smaller impeller size in the volute of the pump, and the result is that motor power is reduced by the cube of the speed reduction, closely following the affinity laws. (Variable-speed pump curves are shown in Chapter 43.) Design flow conditions generally occur for minimal hours of operation per year; as such, the energy savings potential for a variable-speed pump is great. In the general control valve application, a reasonably selected equal percentage valve with a 50% valve authority should reduce flow by about 30% when the valve is positioned from 100% open (design flow, minimal hours per year) to 90% open. The 10% change in stroke should reduce pump operating power about 70%. Hydronic systems should operate most of the time at flow rates well below design. The coil characteristic suggests that, in sensible applications, a small percentage of flow yields an exceptionally high degree of coil design heat transfer, adequate for most of the year's operation.

Depending on system design, direct digital control may also allow more advanced control strategies. There are various reset control strategies (e.g., cascade control) to optimize pump speed and flow performance. Many of these monitor valve position and drive the pump to a level that keeps one valve open while maintaining set point for comfort conditions. Physical operational requirements of the components must be taken into account. There are some concerns over operating pumps and their motor drives at speeds less than 30% of design, particularly about maintaining proper lubrication of the pump mechanical seals and motor bearings. From a practical perspective, 30% speed is a scant 3% of design power, so it may be unnecessary to reduce speed any further. Consult manufacturers for information on device limits, to maintain the system in good operating condition.

Exceptional energy reduction potential and advances in variable-frequency drive technology that have reduced drive costs have made the application of variable-speed drives common on closed hydronic distribution systems. Successful application of a variable-speed drive to a pump is not a given, however, and depends on the designer's skill and understanding of system operation.

For instance, the designer should understand the system curve with system static pressure, as shown in Figure 13. This control phenomenon of variable-speed, variable-flow pumping systems is often called the **control area**; Hegberg (2003) describes the analysis used to create these graphs.

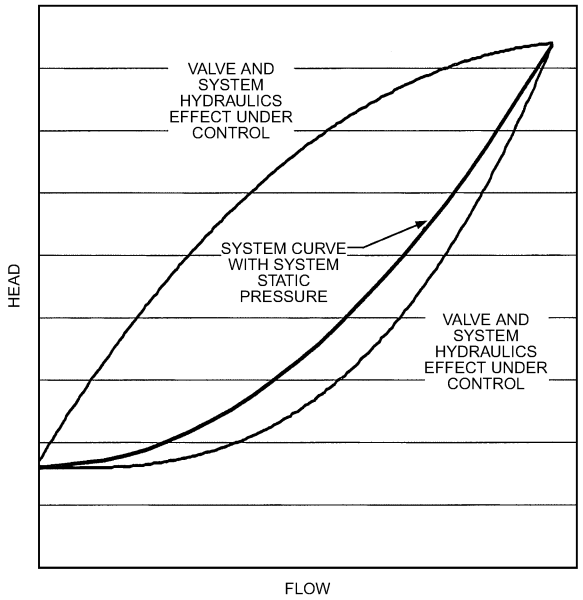

Fig. 13 System Curve with System Static Pressure (Control Area)

The plot represents the system curves of different operation points, created by valve positions, and their intersection points with a pump curve. These discrete points occur under specific imposed points of operation on the control valves of the hydronic system, and represent potential worst-case operation points in the system. Typically, this imposed sequence is that control valves are closed in specific order relative to their location to the controlled pump, and the total dynamic pressure of the pump is calculated at each position. When there is one sensor of control, the boundaries as shown are created. The upper system boundary represents system pressure as valves are closed sequentially, starting with those nearest the pump and ending with those closer to the sensor. The lower boundary curve represents system pressure and flow when valves are closed sequentially from the location of the sensor toward the controlled pump.

The importance of these two boundaries is that, for any given system flow, there are an infinite number of system pressures that may be required, based on which control valves are open and to what position. This is opposite of the system curve concept, which is one flow, one pressure loss in a piping system. The graph is a representation of a controlled operation; the piping system follows the principles of the Darcy equation, but the intervening feedback control adjustments to the pump speed produce an installed characteristic in the system different from what might otherwise be expected. The implication of any boundary above the generic system curve relationship to design flow is that, as flow decreases in the system, it does not follow the affinity law relationship in reducing operating power. Conversely, the boundary below the system curve operates with a greater reduction in power than the generic system curve.

Although operating below the system curve may seem to be advantageous, saving energy and pumping costs, the designer is cautioned to remember that these represent a system flow less than that required for comfort control. This operating series of conditions represents control valve interaction. One valve flow affects flow to all other circuits between it and the pump. This interaction can be quite large. Depending on distribution system pressure loss and system balancing techniques, one valve may reduce system flow by two to three times the individual valve's rated flow. This can negatively affect the control and sequencing of the source, and possibly also the control of the affected terminal units. Controlling this interaction is done by engineering the hydraulic losses and distribution pipe friction pressure losses, using pressure-independent valves (both balancing and control), using sensors at critical points of the hydronic system, and combinations of these strategies.

These issues are part of what has caused debate over system balancing, pump method of control, etc. Simply put, system design dictates the requirements of adjustment and control. Balance of a system is more than having a balancing valve; it involves pipe selection and location combined with valves and coils and, in some cases, pumps, as well as measurement and adjustment devices. Similarly, the effects of one method of pump control over another (e.g., differential pressure control, valve position of pump speed reset) must also be considered. Traditional system design and feedback control techniques use a series of single-loop controllers. These techniques also work on variable-speed pumping systems, but the interaction of all of the individual controlled systems requires analysis by the designer and calculated design choices based on a thorough understanding of the loads, both theoretical and practical, and should also take into account that operators may run systems in a manner not intended by the designer.

Address these issues during design, because they are difficult to understand in the field, and the required instrumentation to monitor the effects is rarely installed. Despite these challenges, application of variable-speed, variable-flow pumping can be very satisfactory. However, variable-speed pumping designs require that the designer allow adequate time in calculation and design iteration to mitigate potential operation issues, and ensure the design criteria of a comfort providing system with operating energy and cost efficiency.

Pump Connection

Pump suction piping should be at least as large as the nozzle serving the pump, and there should be minimal fittings or devices in the suction to obstruct flow. Typically, pump manufacturers prefer five to eight pipe diameters of unobstructed (i.e., no fittings) straight pipe entering the pump. Fittings such as tees and elbows, especially when there is a change in planar direction, cause water to swirl in the pipe; this can be detrimental to pump performance, and may also lead to pump damage. Manufacturers may recommend special fittings in applications where piping space is unavailable to overcome geometry factors. These fittings need to be carefully reviewed in application.

Piping to the pump should be independently supported, adding no load to the pump flanges, which, unless specifically designed for the purpose, are incapable of supporting the system piping. Supporting the pipe weight on the flange can cause serious damage (e.g., breaking the flange), or may induce stresses that misalign the pump. Similar results can also occur when the pipe and pump are improperly aligned to each other, or pipe expansion and contraction are unaccounted for. Flexible couplings are one way to overcome some of these issues, when both the pump and the pipe are supported independently of each other, and the flexible coupling is not arbitrarily connected to the pump and pipe.

When pumps are piped in parallel, these requirements are extended. Pump entering and discharge pressures should be equal in operation. In addition to maintaining the recommended straight inlet pipe to the pump, manifold pipe serving the inlets should also have a minimum of two manifold pipe diameters between pump suction centerlines. Pump discharge manifolds should be constructed to keep discharge velocities less than 3 to 4.5 m/s, and lower when a check valve is applied, because it is necessary to prevent hydraulic shock (water hammer). Soft-seating discharge check valves are required on the pumps to prevent reverse flow from one pump to another. Various specialty valves and fittings are available for serving one or more of these functions.

Distribution System

The distribution system is the piping connecting the various other components of the system. The primary considerations in designing this system are (1) sizing the piping to handle the heating or cooling capacity required and (2) arranging the piping to ensure flow in the quantities required at design conditions and at all other loads.

The flow requirement of the pipe is determined by Equation (8) or (9). After Δt is established based on the thermal requirements, either of these equations (as applicable) can be used to determine the flow rate. First-cost economics and energy consumption make it advisable to design for the greatest practical Δt because the flow rate is inversely proportional to Δt; that is, if Δt doubles, the flow rate is reduced by half.

The three related variables in sizing the pipe are flow rate, pipe size, and pressure drop. The primary consideration in selecting a design pressure drop is the relationship between the economics of first cost and energy costs. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1-2022's Table 6.5.4.6 defines design maximum flow rates by pipe size and system application, thereby defining minimum pipe size. Increasing pipe size further increases first cost but reduces energy costs.

Once the distribution system is designed, the pressure loss at design flow is calculated by the methods discussed in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.A system curve (see Figure 14) can also be plotted..

The system curve changes if anything occurs to change the flow/pressure drop characteristics. Examples include a strainer that starts to block or a control valve closing, either of which increases the pressure loss at any given flow rate, thus changing the system curve in a direction from curve A to curve B in Figure 14.

This type of evaluation can help determine the effects of control and component selection in system operation. The designer cannot assume that the control system will compensate for poor selections and unnoticed installation mistakes. Anecdotal data suggest that numerous adjustments are required when selection and operation techniques are poor. There is also a need for system balance when the pump is correctly sized: no excess pressure is added to the pump; the balance device adds pressure only to the circuits for coils 1 and 2 to compensate for the difference in friction loss as water goes from one terminal takeoff to another. System flow is reduced to design, and no extra energy input is required for the pump.

Expansion Chamber

As a hydraulic device, the expansion tank serves as the reference pressure point in the system, analogous to a ground in an electrical system (Lockhart and Carlson 1953). Where the tank connects to the piping, the pressure equals the pressure of the air in the tank plus or minus any fluid pressure caused by the elevation difference between the tank liquid surface and the pipe (Figure 15).

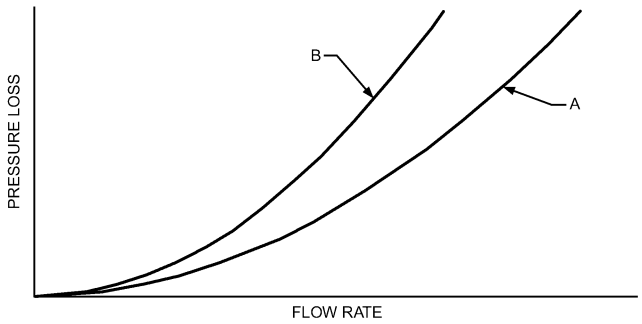

Fig. 14 Typical System Curves for Closed System

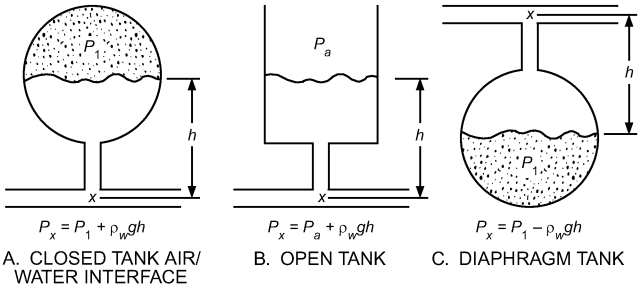

Fig. 15 Tank Pressure Related to System Pressure

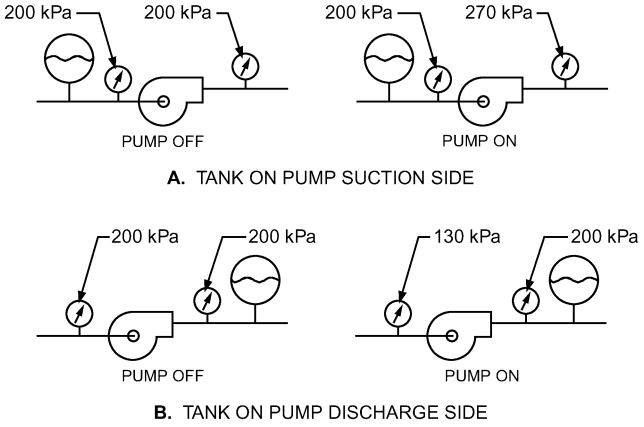

Fig. 16 Effect of Expansion Tank Location with Respect to Pump Pressure

A closed system should have only one expansion chamber. Having more than one chamber or excessive amounts of undissolved air in a piping system can cause the closed system to behave in unintended (but understandable) ways, causing extensive damage from shock waves or water hammer.

With a single chamber on a system, assuming isothermal conditions for the air, the air pressure can change only as a result of displacement by the water. The only thing that can cause the water to move into or out of the tank (assuming no water is being added to or removed from the system) is expansion or shrinkage of the water in the system. Thus, in sizing the tank, thermal expansion is related to the pressure extremes of the air in the tank [Equations (13), (14), and (15)].

The point of connection of the tank should be based on the pressure requirements of the system, remembering that the pressure at the tank connection will not change as the pump is turned on or off. For example, consider a system containing an expansion tank at 200 kPa (gage) and a pump with a pump pressure of 70 kPa (gage). Figure 16 shows alternative locations for connecting the expansion tank; in either case, with the pump off, the pressure will be 200 kPa (gage) on both the pump suction and discharge. With the tank on the pump suction side, when the pump is turned on, the pressure increases on the discharge side by an amount equal to the pump pressure (Figure 16A). With the tank on the discharge side of the pump, the pressure decreases on the suction side by the same amount (Figure 16B).

Other tank connection considerations include the following:

- A tank open to the atmosphere must be located above the highest point in the system, or be equipped with pressure-sustaining valves (as used in thermal storage applications).

- A tank with an air/water interface is generally used with an air control system that continually revents air into the tank. For this reason, connect it at a point where air can best be released.
- Within reason, the lower the pressure in a tank, the smaller the tank is [see Equations (13) and (15)]. Thus, in a vertical system, the higher the tank is placed, the smaller it can be.

2.4 PIPING CIRCUITS

Hydronic systems are designed with many different configurations of piping circuits. In addition to simple preference by the design engineer, the method of arranging circuiting can be dictated by such factors as the shape or configuration of the building, the economics of installation, energy economics, the nature of the load, part-load capabilities or requirements, and others.

Each piping system is a network; the more extensive the network, the more complex it is to understand, analyze, or control. Thus, a major design objective is to maximize simplicity.

Load distribution circuits are of four general types:

- Full series
- Diverting series
- Parallel direct return
- Parallel reverse return

A simple **series** circuit is shown in Figure 17. Series loads generally have the advantages of lower piping costs and higher temperature drops, resulting in smaller pipe size and lower energy consumption. A disadvantage is that the different circuits cannot be controlled separately. Simple series circuits are generally limited to residential and small commercial standing radiation systems. Figure 18 shows a typical layout of such a system with two zones for residential or small commercial heating.

The simplest **diverting series** circuit diverts some flow from the main piping circuit through a special diverting tee to a load device (usually standing radiation) that has a low pressure drop. This system is generally limited to heating systems in residential or small commercial applications.

Figure 19 illustrates a typical one-pipe diverting tee circuit. For each terminal unit, a supply and a return tee are installed on the main. One of the two tees is a special diverting tee that creates pressure drop in the main flow to divert part of the flow to the unit. One (return) diverting tee is usually sufficient for upfeed (units above the main) systems. Two special fittings (supply and return tees) are usually required to overcome thermal pressure in downfeed units. Special tees are proprietary; consult the manufacturer's literature for flow rates and pressure drop data on these devices. Unit selection can be only approximate without these data.

One-pipe diverting series circuits allow manual or automatic control of flow to individual heating units. On/off rather than flow modulation control is preferred because of the relatively low pressure drop allowable through the control valve in the diverted flow circuit. This system is likely to cost more than the series loop because extra branch pipe and fittings, including special tees, are required. Each unit usually requires a manual air vent because of the low water velocity through the unit. The length and load imposed on a one-pipe circuit are usually small because of these limitations.

Because only a fraction of the main flow is diverted in a one-pipe circuit, the flow rate and pressure drop are less variable as water flow to the load is controlled than in some other circuits. When two or more one-pipe circuits are connected to the same two-pipe mains, the circuit flow may need to be mechanically balanced. After balancing, sufficient flow must be maintained in each one-pipe circuit to ensure adequate flow diversion to the loads.

When coupled with compound pumping systems, series circuits can be applied to multiple control zones on larger commercial or institutional systems (Figure 20). Note that in the series circuit with

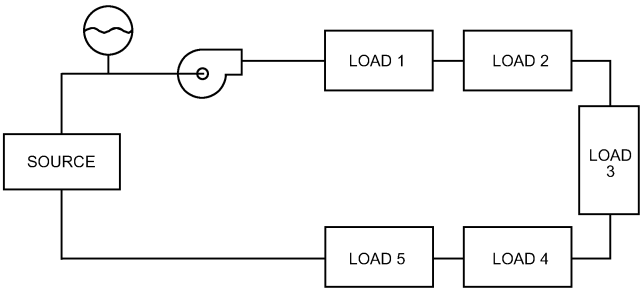

Fig. 17 Flow Diagram of Simple Series Circuit

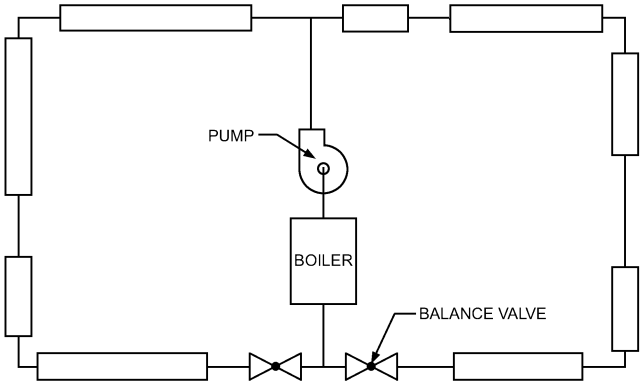

Fig. 18 Series Loop System

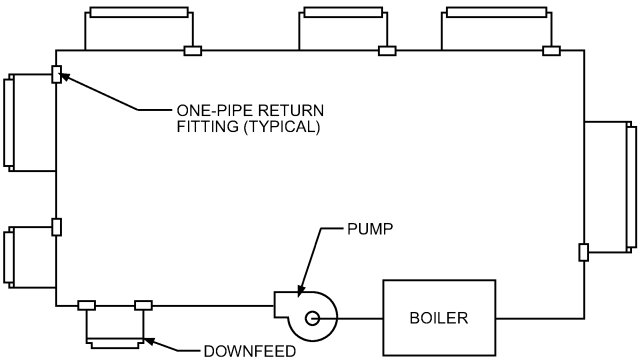

Fig. 19 One-Pipe Diverting Tee System

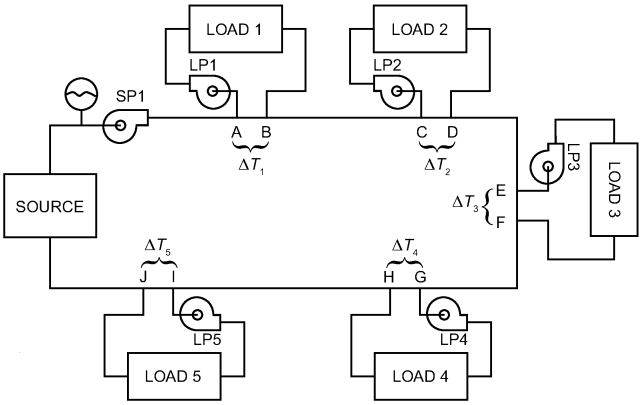

Fig. 20 Series Circuit with Load Pumps

compound pumping, the load pumps need not be equal in capacity to the system pump. If, for example, load pump LP1 circulates less flow (Q_{LP1}) than system pump SP1 (Q_{SP1}), the temperature difference across load 1 would be greater than the circuit temperature difference between A and B (i.e., water would flow in the common pipe from A to B). If, on the other hand, the load pump LP2 is equal in flow capacity to the system pump SP1, the temperature differentials across load 2 and across the system from C to D would be equal and no water would flow in the common pipe. If Q_{LP3} exceeds Q_{SP1}, mixing occurs at point E and, in a heating system, the temperature entering pump LP3 would be lower than that available from the system leaving load connection D.

Thus, a series circuit using compound or load pumps offers many design options. Each of the loads shown in Figure 20 could also be a complete piping circuit or network.

Parallel piping networks are the most commonly used in hydronic systems because they allow the same temperature water to be available to all loads. The two types of parallel networks are direct-return and reverse-return (Figure 21).

In the **direct-return** system, the length of supply and return piping through the subcircuits is unequal, which may cause unbalanced flow rates and require careful balancing to provide each subcircuit with design flow. Ideally, the **reverse-return** system provides nearly equal total lengths for all terminal circuits.

Direct-return piping has been successfully applied where the designer has guarded against major flow unbalance by

- Providing for pressure drops in the subcircuits or terminals that are significant percentages of the total, usually establishing pressure drops for close subcircuits at higher values than those for the far subcircuits
- Minimizing distribution piping pressure drop (in the limit, if the distribution piping loss is zero and the loads are of equal flow resistance, the system is inherently balanced)
- Including balancing devices and some means of measuring flow at each terminal or branch circuit
- Using control valves with a high pressure loss at the terminals

Carlson (1968) described the effects of distribution piping friction loss on total system flow to terminals in constant speed pumping systems through a **branch-to-riser pressure drop ratio (BRPDR)**. This concept helps minimize distribution losses. In constant-speed pumping systems, a BRPDR of 4:1 yielded a flow of 95% of design in all terminals at part-load conditions, 90% at 2:1, and 80% at 1:1. Application of this ratio helps alleviate system balancing problems without adjusting a controlling device. When used with variable-speed, variable-flow pumping systems, the control area can be minimized and control interaction can be alleviated. It also helps minimize overall friction losses, which reduces required pump power and energy use.

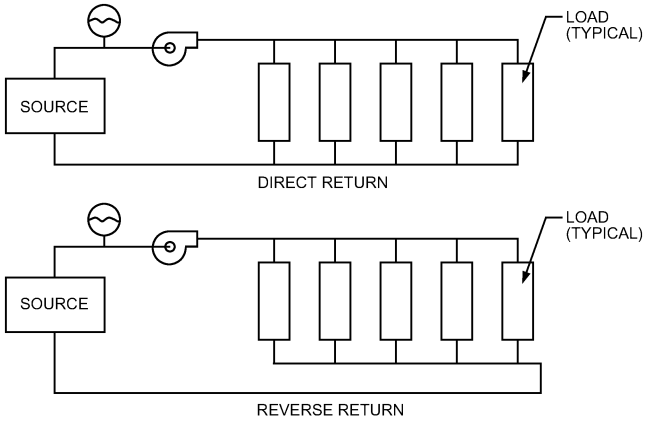

Fig. 21 Direct- and Reverse-Return Two-Pipe Systems

2.5 CAPACITY CONTROL OF LOAD SYSTEM

The two alternatives for controlling the capacity of hydronic systems are on/off control and variable-capacity or modulating control. The on/off option is generally limited to smaller systems (e.g., residential or small commercial) and individual components of larger systems. In smaller systems where the entire building is a single zone, control is accomplished by cycling the source device (the boiler or chiller) on and off. Usually a space thermostat allows the chiller or boiler to run, then a water temperature thermostat (aquastat) controls the capacity of the chiller(s) or boiler(s) as a function of supply or return water temperature. The pump can be either cycled with the load device (usually the case in a residential heating system) or left running (usually done in commercial hot- or chilled-water systems).

In these single-zone applications, the piping design requires no special consideration for control. Where multiple zones of control are required, the various load devices are controlled first; then the source system capacity is controlled to follow the capacity requirement of the loads.

Control valves are commonly used to control loads. These valves control the capacity of each load by varying the amount of water flow through the load device when load pumps are not used. Control valves for hydronic systems are straight-through (two-way) valves and three-way valves (Figure 22). The effect of either valve is to vary the amount of water flowing through the load device.

With a two-way valve (Figure 22A), as the valve strokes from full-open to full-closed, the quantity of water flowing through the load gradually decreases from design flow to no flow. With a three-way mixing valve (Figure 22B) in one position, the valve is open from port A to AB, with port B closed off. In that position, all the flow is through the load. As the valve moves from the A-AB position to the B-AB position, some of the water bypasses the load by flowing through the bypass line, thus decreasing flow through the load. At the end of the stroke, port A is closed, and all of the fluid flows from B to AB with no flow through the load. Thus, the three-way mixing valve has the same effect on the load as the two-way valve: as the load reduces, the quantity of water flowing through the load decreases.

The effect on load control with the three-way diverting valve (Figure 22C) is the same as with the mixing valve in a closed system: the flow is either directed through the load or through the bypass in proportion to the load. Because of the dynamics of valve operation, diverting valves are more complex in design and are thus more expensive than mixing valves; because they accomplish the same function as the simpler mixing valve, they are seldom used in closed hydronic systems.

In terms of load control, a two-way valve and a three-way valve perform identical functions: varying flow through the load as the load changes. The fundamental difference is that as the source or distribution system sees the load, the two-way valve provides a

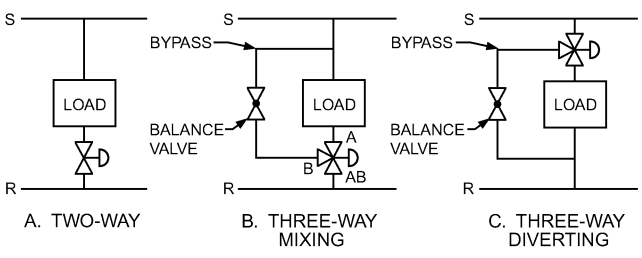

Fig. 22 Load Control Valves

variable-flow load response and the three-way valve provides a constant-flow load response.

According to Equation (9), load q is proportional to the product of Q and Δt. Ideally, as the load changes, Q changes, while Δt remains fixed. However, as the system sees it, as the load changes with the two-way valve, Q varies and Δt is fixed, whereas with a three-way valve, Δt varies and Q is fixed. This principle is illustrated in Figure 23. Understanding this concept is fundamental to design or analysis of hydronic systems.

The flow characteristics of two- and three-way valve ports are described in Chapter 7 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* and in Chapter 47 of this volume, and must be understood. The equal percentage characteristic is recommended for proportional control of load flow for two- and three-way valves; the bypass flow port of three-way valves should have the linear characteristic to maintain a uniform flow during part-load operation.

Sizing Control Valves

Systems designed around closed-loop, constant-speed pumping systems with low-differential-temperature coils are considered forgiving in operation; as system complexity increases, however, the advanced strategies used require diligence and examination to evaluate valve performance and selection.

General pressure drops are commonly applied to valve sizing. Values chosen roughly correspond to the pressure loss on a coil, although there is no literature to explain why these values are used.

Using the concept of valve authority, the relationship is

$$\beta = \frac{\Delta P_{valve}}{(\Delta P_{valve} + \Delta P_{branch})} \times 100 \quad (17)$$

where β is authority.

Common practice has been to assume that, if the coil and the valve have the same pressure drop, they have equal authority of 50%, and that stable control is established. This belief is a rule of thumb, and depends on the type of pumped system and intervening control actions. Using flow coefficient analysis, however, results in a slightly modified definition for authority, comparing the flow coefficient of the valve to the coefficient of the remaining system components. The authority of 50%, then, is representative of the two components having equal flow coefficients, which implies that the valve pressure drop is much greater than the coil pressure drop.

Selection of the proper valve and its corresponding pressure drop requires analysis of the method of control to be used based on the desired response of the controlled system. Depending on the applied control theory and required level of performance, some systems may be run with an on/off control mode, in which case a two-position valve is used. The pressure drop applied on the valve may be minimal, as long as flow through the corresponding circuit is limited in some way to design flow and heat transfer flow tolerance.

More complex systems with fast time constants or that attempt to match seasonal production to load use modulating throttling valves.

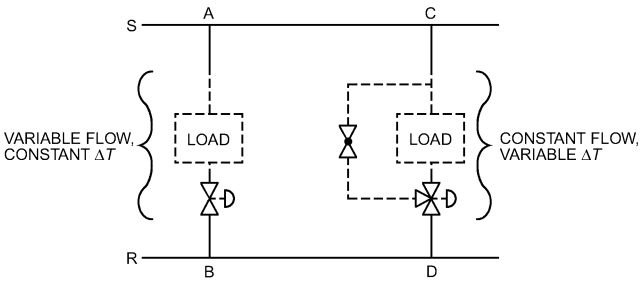

Fig. 23 System Flow with Two-Way and Three-Way Valves

In these applications, heat transfer characteristic of the coil and the flow control characteristic of the installed control valve (under the effects of authority) and the desired controller gain are analyzed (Figures 24 and 25). The graphic solution of the two characteristics (coil and valve authority) has traditionally yielded a linear function so that the simple proportional controller could have a constant gain of one over the operation of the modulating control valve (Figures 26 to 28). This should not imply that this is the only method for sizing a valve, or that linearity is the only allowable control characteristic. Controllers represent devices implementing a mathematical argument. Knowledge of control theory or programming of different

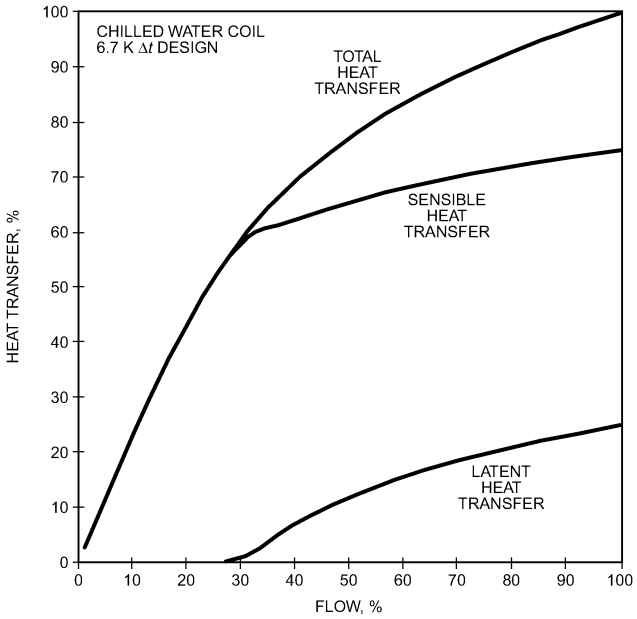

Fig. 24 Chilled-Water Coil Heat Transfer Characteristic

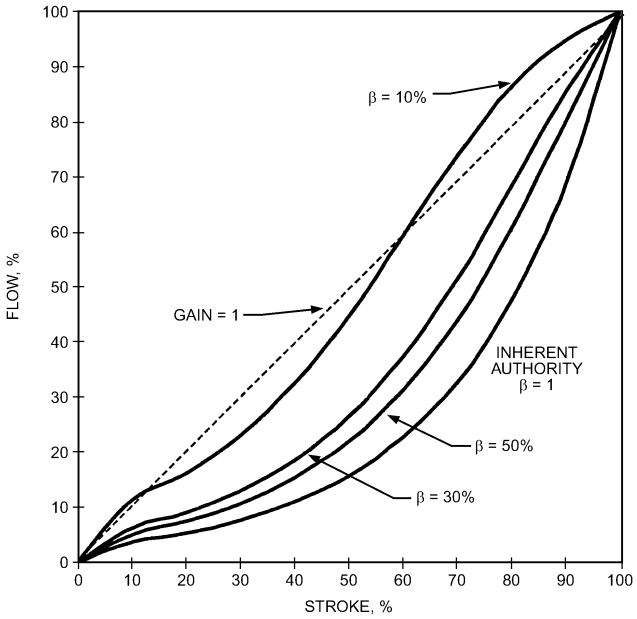

Fig. 25 Equal-Percentage Valve Characteristic with Authority

mathematical relationships is acceptable as long as all of the effects of such action are determined by the designer. However, linear control algorithms such as proportional with integral (PI) and proportional with integral and derivative (PID) control are the most common in HVAC systems, and should be considered in the application of the devices applied to the hydronic system.

Experience in of applied control systems shows the following general guidance.

Proportional control is adequate for slowly changing, single-variable systems such as space temperature control. Many of these applications may have slow response time, with time constants for temperature change on the order of 10 to 50 min or more, so a properly applied proportional controller with a properly applied valve and coil characteristic can perform adequately, and may approach simple on/off or valve-open/valve-closed implementation with minimal noticeable temperature hunting in the space. There is a reasonable history of the application of PI control in this application, also. In systems with extra effects, such as variable-speed pumping systems, PI control may be necessary to deal with the control errors introduced when variables outside the direct control loop modify the valve output. Note that applying variable-speed drives to pumps and blowers significantly affects a controlled device's ability to achieve its design differential pressure, because there is an extra variable in the system, with corresponding downstream effects. The effects are the result of the changes that occur in piping system pressure distribution because of changes in flow and corresponding pressures, as affected by the control set point and measurement responses in the pump controller. These effects can be significant or negligible, depending on how the piping system friction loss has been designed and distributed. Understanding variable-speed pump system control area and distribution of predicted dynamic flow in the building through energy analysis requires significant calculation, but may be necessary in certain applications.

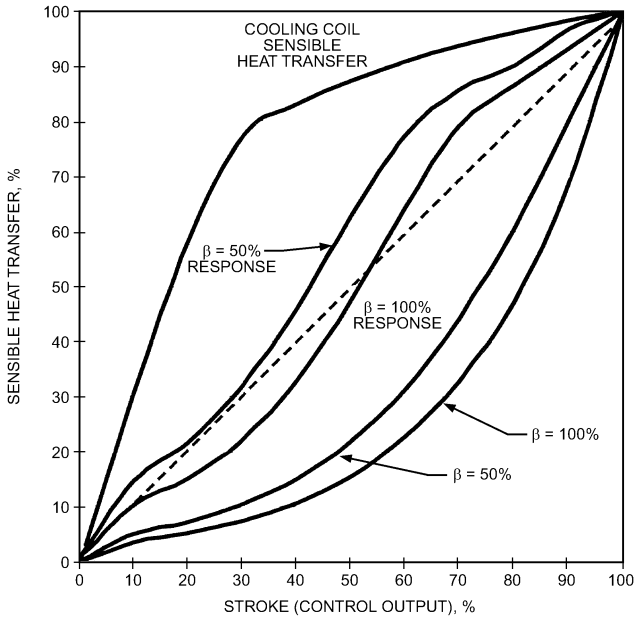

Fig. 26 Control Valve and Coil Response, Inherent and 50% Authority

Although **proportional-integral controllers** can be applied to simple systems, they are more often required for primary space and fluid conditioning systems such as discharge temperature control of an air-handling unit, or pressure/flow control of a pumping system. In practice, devices that exhibit fast response time and have low time constants are candidates for PI controller application, and possibly also for additional derivative control action. Generally, these control modes are applied through application of direct digital controls (DDC). Thorough understanding of the applied controller's implementation of the PID algorithm is required to understand the complete effects of each control action. In some cases, the cyclic nature of the generic DDC device or a specific manufacturer's feature may limit unwanted responses, or add stabilization to the output signal very different from the generic mathematical PID controller algorithm.

For example, in Figure 23, the pressure drop at full-open position for the two-way valve should be great enough from A to B that, when the flow coefficient analysis is performed and combined with the coil characteristic (Figure 24) a straight line is developed (Fig-

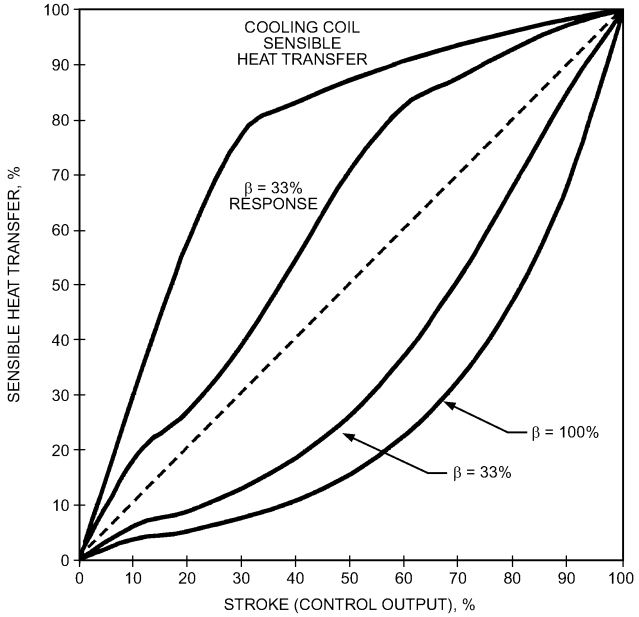

Fig. 27 Control Valve and Coil Response, 33% Authority

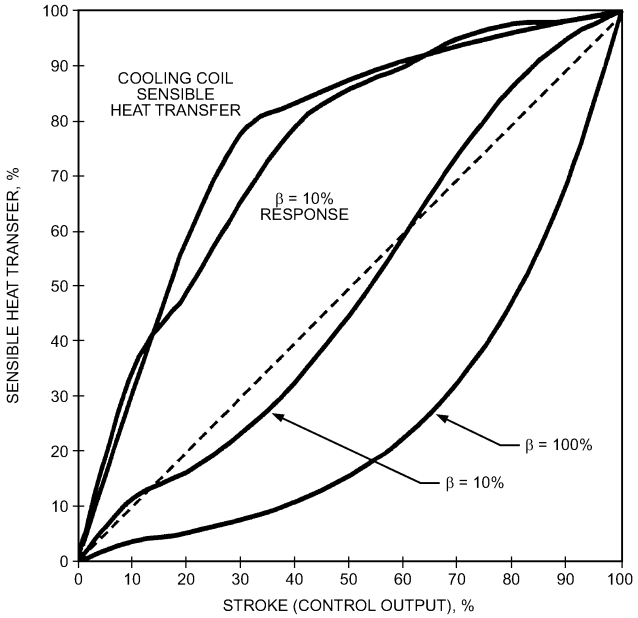

Fig. 28 Coil Valve and Coil Response, 10% Authority

ures 25 and 26). Typically, authorities in the range of 30 to 50% (for piping systems with 2:1 branch-to-riser pressure drop ratios) are adequate for HVAC coil applications, with higher Δt coils requiring less valve authority. Authorities less than 30% should be avoided because they lead to a flow characteristic shift that makes the equal-percentage valve appear to be more linear in nature (Figures 27 and 28). For the three-way valve shown in Figure 23, the full-open pressure drop should be from C to D. The pressure drop in the bypass balancing valve in the three-way valve circuit should be set to equal that in the coil (load), Chapter 47 discusses valve authority in three way modulating applications.

Control valves should be sized on the basis of the required valve coefficient C_v for the required pressure drop and flow. For more information, see the section on Control Valve Sizing under Automatic Valves in Chapter 47. Briefly, in variable-speed pumping systems using differential pressure control of the branch, the pressure drop of concern is the controlled differential, and is generally placed to measure the valve and coil pressure drops. The valve pressure drop for control, then, is that required to provide complementary characteristic. In the previous coils, a 6.7 K Δt was used, and valve authority of 50 to 100% provides good results, implying a pressure drop on the valve equal to that of the coil. Control valves that follow are thus dependent on the controlled hydraulic performance. In these valves, attention must also be paid to valve construction (especially the maximum pressure allowed on the valve body, and maximum allowed pressure drop across the valve).

If a system is to be designed with multiple zones of control such that load response is to be by constant flow through the load and variable Δt, control cannot be achieved by valve control alone; a load pump is required.

Several control arrangements of load pump and control valve configurations are shown in Figure 29. Note that, in all three configurations, the common pipe has no restriction or check valve. In all configurations, there is no difference in control as seen by the load. However, the basic differences in control are

- With the two-way valve configuration (Figure 29A), the distribution system sees variable flow and constant Δt, whereas with both three-way configurations, the distribution system sees constant flow and variable Δt.
- Configuration B differs from C in that the pressure required through the three-way valve in Figure 29B is provided by the load pump, whereas in Figure 29C it is provided by the distribution pump(s).

Alternatives to Control Valves

Use of variable-frequency drives has greatly increased because advances in technology and decreases in cost have made these drives an attractive alternative to using control valves for heat transfer control (Figure 30).

Green (1994) tested the control stability of variable-speed circulating pumps compared to control valves. Stability of the controlled discharge temperature of the coil was on the order of ±0.28 K. Large coils with pump and separate drive may also be economical compared to similarly sized valves and actuators. The stability of on/off pump control was also found to be reasonable. The attraction of a pump over a control valve is the reduction of pressure and thus energy used by the distribution pumping system. For the valve to work properly, pump pressure must be throttled to control flow. Any throttling process is inherently energy inefficient. Direct load control by a pump provides only the energy required to overcome the friction loss of the load heat transfer device and piping. Properly sequenced, the distribution pumping system can reduce flow, which causes higher coil entering water temperatures, which causes the circulating pump to operate at a higher flow. This is helpful in allowing for higher percentages of heat transfer capability of the sensible and latent loads through the coil. Applications of this control method must also take into account the potential of gravity flow in the piping scheme.

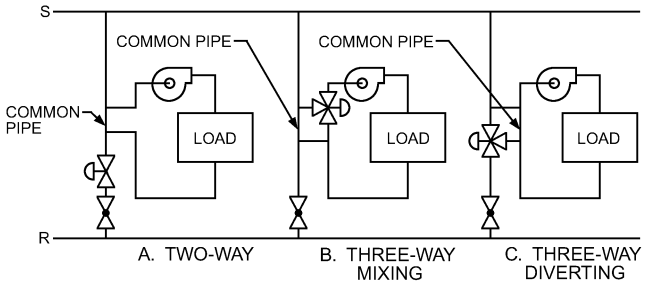

Fig. 29 Load Pumps with Valve Control

2.6 LOW-TEMPERATURE HEATING SYSTEMS

These systems are used for heating spaces or processes directly, as with standing radiation and process heat exchangers, or indirectly, through air-handling unit coils for preheating, for reheating, or in hot-water unit heaters. They are generally designed with supply water temperatures from 80 to 115°C and temperature drops from 10 to 55 K.

In the United States, hot-water heating systems were historically designed for a 93°C supply water temperature and an 11 K temperature drop. This practice evolved from earlier gravity system designs and provides convenient design relationships for heat transfer coefficients related to coil tubing and finned-tube radiation and for calculations. Because many terminal devices still require these flow rates, it is important to recognize this relationship in selecting devices and designing systems.

However, the greater the temperature range (and related lower flow rate) that can be applied, the less costly the system is to install and operate. A lower flow rate requires smaller and less expensive piping, less secondary building space, and smaller pumps. Also, smaller pumps require less energy, so operating costs are lower.

Nonresidential Heating Systems

Possible approaches to enhancing the economics of large heating systems include (1) higher supply temperatures, (2) primary/secondary pumping, and (3) terminal equipment designed for smaller flow rates. The three techniques may be used either singly or in combination.

Using higher supply water temperatures achieves higher temperature drops and smaller flow rates. Terminal units with a reduced heat-

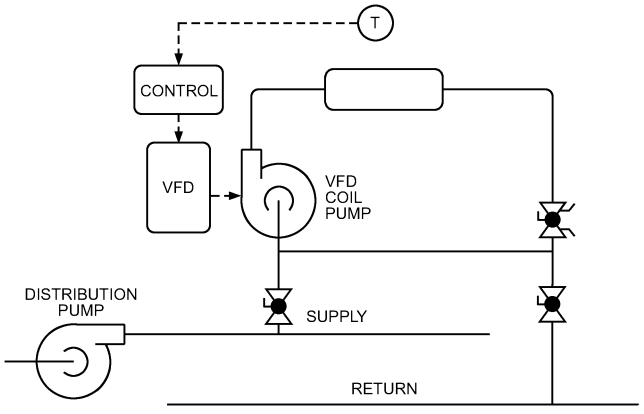

Fig. 30 Schematic of Variable-Speed Pump Coil Control

ing surface can be used. These smaller terminals are not necessarily less expensive, however, because their required operating temperatures and pressures may increase manufacturing costs and the problems of pressurization, corrosion, expansion, and control. System components may not increase in cost uniformly with temperature, but rather in steps conforming to the three major temperature classifications. Within each classification, the most economical design uses the highest temperature in that classification.

Primary/secondary or compound pumping reduces the size and cost of the distribution system and also may use larger flows and lower temperatures in the terminal or secondary circuits. A primary pump circulates water in the primary distribution system while one or more secondary pumps circulate the terminal circuits. The connection between primary and secondary circuits provides complete hydraulic isolation of both circuits and allows a controlled interchange of water between the two. Thus, a high supply water temperature can be used in the primary circuit at a low flow rate and high temperature drop, while a lower temperature and conventional temperature drop is used in the secondary circuit(s).

For example, a system could be designed with primary/secondary pumping in which the supply temperature from the boiler was 115°C, the supply temperature in the secondary was 95°C, and the return temperature was 85°C. This design results in a conventional 10 K Δt in the secondary zones, but allows the primary circuit to be sized on the basis of a 30 K drop. This primary/secondary pumping arrangement is most advantageous with terminal units such as convectors and finned radiation, which are generally unsuited for small flow rate design.

Many types of terminal heat transfer units are being designed to use smaller flow rates with temperature drops up to 55 K in low-temperature systems and up to 85 K in medium-temperature systems. Fan apparatus, the heat transfer surface used for air heating in fan systems, and water-to-water heat exchangers are most adaptable to such design.

A fourth technique is to put certain loads in series using a combination of control valves and compound pumping (Figure 31). In the system illustrated, the capacity of the boiler or heat exchanger is 600 kW, and each of the four loads is 150 kW. Under design conditions, the system is designed for a 40 K water temperature drop, and the loads each provide 10 K of the total Δt. The loads in these systems, as well as the smaller or simpler systems in residential or commercial applications, can be connected in a direct-return or a reverse-return piping system. The different features of each load are as follows:

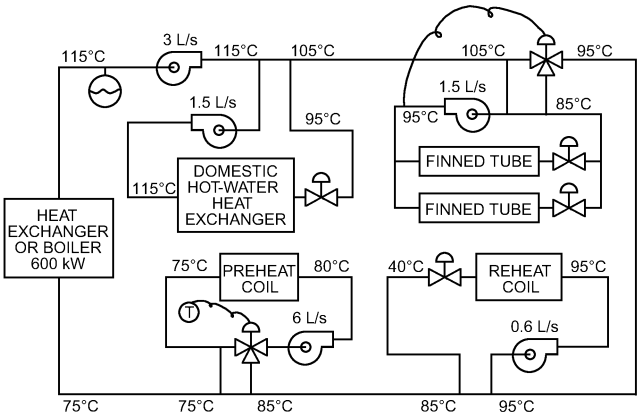

Fig. 31 Example of Series-Connected Loading

- The domestic hot-water heat exchanger has a two-way valve and is thus arranged for variable flow (the main distribution circuit provides constant flow for the boiler circuit).
- The finned-tube radiation circuit is a 10 K Δt circuit with the design entering water temperature reduced to and controlled at 95°C.
- The reheat coil circuit takes a 55 K temperature drop for a very low flow rate.
- The preheat coil circuit provides constant flow through the coil to keep it from freezing.

When loads such as water-to-air heating coils in LTW systems are valve-controlled (flow varies), they have a heating characteristic of flow versus capacity as shown in Figure 32 for 10 K and 30 K temperature drops. For a 10 K Δt coil, 50% flow provides approximately 90% capacity; valve control will tend to be unstable. For this reason, proportional temperature control is required, and equal percentage characteristic two-way valves should be selected such that 10% flow is achieved with 50% valve lift. This combination of the valve characteristic and the heat transfer characteristic of the coil makes control linear with respect to the control signal. This type of control can be obtained only with equal percentage two-way valves and can be further enhanced if piped with a secondary pump arrangement as shown in Figure 29A. See Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for further information on automatic controls.

2.7 CHILLED-WATER SYSTEMS

Designers have less latitude in selecting supply water temperatures for cooling applications because there is only a narrow range of water temperatures low enough to provide adequate dehumidification and high enough to avoid chiller freeze-up. Circulated water quantities can be reduced by selecting proper air quantities and heat transfer surface at the terminals. Terminals suited for a 9 to 11 K rise rather than a 5 to 7 K rise reduce circulated water quantity and pump power by more than half. Section 6.5.4.7 of ANSI/ASHRAE/IES *Standard* 90.1-2022 requires that chilled-water cooling coils provide at least a 8°C temperature difference between leaving and entering water temperatures and at least 14°C leaving water temperature at design conditions.

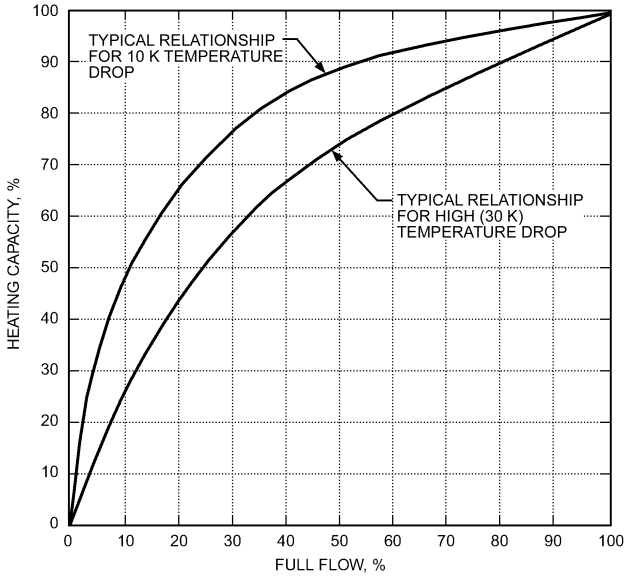

Fig. 32 Heat Emission Versus Flow Characteristic of Typical Hot-Water Heating Coil

Table 1 Chilled-Water Coil Performance

Coil Circuiting	Chilled-Water Inlet Temp., °C	Coil Pressure Drop, kPa	Chilled-Water Flow, mL/(s·kW)	Chilled-Water Temp. Rise, °C
Full[a]	7.2	6.9	39	6.1
Half[b]	7.2	37.9	30	8.3
Full[a]	4.5	3.4	25	9.5
Half[b]	4.5	17.2	20	12.1

Note: Table is based on cooling air from 27°C db, 19°C wb to 14°C db, 13°C wb.
[a] Full circuiting (also called single circuit). Water at the inlet temperature flows simultaneously through all tubes in a plane transverse to airflow; it then flows simultaneously through all tubes, in unison, in successive planes (i.e., rows) of the coil.
[b] Half circuiting. Tube connections are arranged so there are half as many circuits as there are tubes in each plane (row), thereby using higher water velocities through the tubes. This circuiting is used with small water quantities.

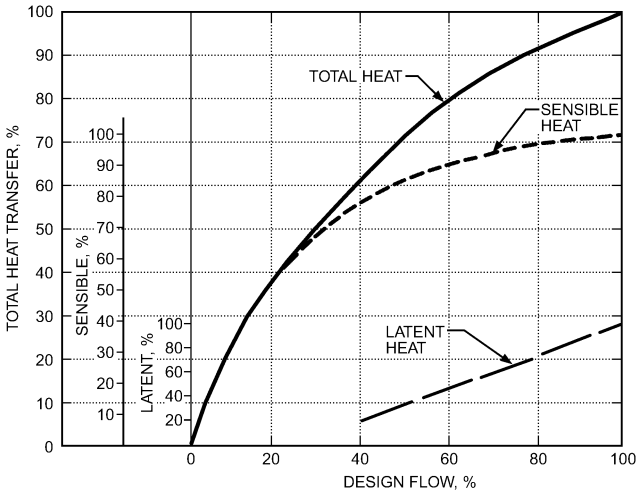

Fig. 33 Generic Chilled-Water Coil Heat Transfer Characteristic

Evaluate proposed systems for the desired balance between installation cost and operating cost. Table 1 shows the effect of coil circuiting and chilled-water temperature on water flow and temperature rise. This yields a coil characteristic not unlike the heating coil shown in Figure 33. The characteristic, though, should be shown as total, sensible, and latent heat transfer. The coil rows, fin spacing, air-side performance, and cost are identical for all selections. Morabito (1960) showed how such changes in coil circuiting affect the overall system. Considering the investment cost of piping and insulation versus the operating cost of refrigeration and pumping motors, higher temperature rises, (i.e., 9 to 13 K temperature rise at about 18 to 27 mL/s per kilowatt of cooling capacity) can be applied on chilled-water systems with long distribution piping runs; larger flow rates should be used only where reasonable in close-coupled systems.

For the most economical design, the minimum flow rate to each terminal heat exchanger is calculated. For example, if one terminal can be designed for a 10 K rise, another for 8 K, and others for 7 K, the highest rise to each terminal should be used, rather than designing the system for an overall temperature rise based on the smallest capability.

The control system selected also influences the design water flow. The expense of operating chilled-water systems, combined with the complexity of interrelated system variables, demands direct digital control. Evaluation suggests that, in many cases, a minimum of PI control is required, if not PID. To control flow, the designer should apply two-way modulating control valves, matching the required characteristic to the coil's operational characteristic. The control system programmer may need some method of linearizing through programming the controller output to the combined characteristic of the control valve and the selected coil.

For systems with multiple terminal units, use care in applying diversity factors, which can negatively affect not only chiller selection, but also pump selection. Designers should apply variable-speed pumping techniques to the system pumps. System balancing is best accomplished with automatic flow-limiting valves, with the pumps capable of either providing the coil block flow load, or limiting the stroke of the control valves in conditions where single-loop controllers would tend to open all valves at once (e.g., at start-up). This is necessary to prevent a no-flow condition from occurring in coils farther from the pump.

A primary consideration with chilled-water system design is control of the source systems at reduced loads. The constraints on the temperature parameters are (1) a water freezing temperature of 0°C, (2) economics of the cooling system in generating chilled water, and (3) the dew-point temperature of the air at nominal indoor comfort conditions (13°C dew point at 24°C and 50% rh).

These parameters have led to the common practice of designing for a supply chilled-water temperature of 3 to 7°C and a return water temperature between 13 to 19°C. However, Pederson et al. (1998) suggest an alternative classic design methodology for selecting entering water temperature to the chilled-water coil, based on the coil's dew-point temperature.

Final selection of the design criteria should be judged against the required flow tolerance of the coil to the required heat transfer characteristics of the coil. Carlson (1981) notes relationships for entering and differential temperatures of the coil as it compares to providing 97% of design heat transfer, and compares the required flow as a percentage of design for the purpose of specifying hydronic system balancing, and selection of the distribution system friction loss.

With increasing entering water temperatures and selection differential temperatures, the coil characteristic becomes very sensitive to changes in flow at the design condition. Carlson (1981) showed that flow tolerance to the coil could be as high as ±20% flow for low Δt designs, but the tolerance became much closer (±5% flow or less) for coils with higher differential-temperature designs (Figure 34). The concern was providing adequate flow for adequate coil heat transfer at a design condition, without grossly overflowing the coil. Carlson (1981) suggested a maximum allowable flow tolerance of ±10% design flow at design flow conditions to enhance operating system energy efficiency. Many devices are available to help achieve this. However, because coil heat transfer sensitivity to flow increases as water-side differential temperature increases, designers must weigh coil design criteria, pipe sizing decisions, and balancing interactions. From a practical perspective, many balancing devices can achieve ±10% flow adjustment or better, and in some cases meet or exceed ±5% flow adjustment. However, as Figure 34 indicates, changes in water-side design Δt and entering air conditions to the coil offer the potential for losing some high-flow heat transfer if design flows cannot be accomplished. This requires that flow be balanced as closely to design as possible so the required heat transfer for design condition can be met. If the designer has concerns with temperature and humidity control in the space, the maximum potential operating energy efficiency of the system (characterized by higher coil design differential temperatures and lower flows) must be balanced with the required comfort conditions of the space and the ability to control them based on the operating interactions of all system components (pipe, valve, fitting friction loss, coil operation, and control system sensitivity to adjustment). The designer must take care to achieve the desired operation. Combined with energy-sensible concepts such as variable-speed, variable-flow pumping and the potential flow interaction of the control valve, the designer must carefully analyze the system loads and consider all

system effects. Figure 34 shows one approach for of this type of analysis. However, it shows that heat transfer, and potentially comfort, is affected if flow to a coil varies too much. System designers should consider similar types of analysis based on their selected design parameters.

Figure 35 shows a typical configuration of small chilled-water systems, using two parallel chillers and loads with three-way valves. Note that flow should be essentially constant, although the valve characteristic and authority could cause more or less than design flow at part-load (valve stroke) conditions. A simple energy balance (Equation [9]) dictates that, with a constant flow rate, at one-half of design load, the water temperature differential drops to one-half of design. At this load, if one of the chillers is turned off, the return water circulating through the off chiller mixes with the supply water. This mixing raises the temperature of the supply chilled water and can cause a loss of control if the designer does not consider this operating mode. A better approach is to use a modulated system instead, to enhance operating efficiency and meet the requirements of building energy codes as presented in ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1.

A typical configuration of a large chilled-water system with multiple chillers and loads and compound piping is shown in Figure 36. This system provides variable flow, essentially constant-supply-temperature chilled water, multiple chillers, more stable two-way control valves, and the advantage of adding chilled-water storage with little additional complexity. As mentioned, mixing in the transition of chillers can be of concern, but using variable-speed drives can help eliminate the issue while keeping the benefit of hydraulic organization.

One design issue, shown in Figure 36, is the placement of the common pipe for the chillers. With the common pipe as shown, the chillers unload from left to right (sometimes called **preferential loading**). With the common pipe in the alternative location shown, the chillers unload equally in proportion to their capacity (i.e., equal percentage).

The **one-pipe chilled-water system**, also called the **integrated decentralized chilled-water system**, is another system that has seen considerable use in campus-type chilled-water systems with multiple chillers and multiple buildings (Coad 1976). A single pumped main circulates water in a closed loop through all the connected buildings. Each load and/or chiller is connected to the loop, with the chillers usually downstream from a load connection. Loop capacity is limited only by the fact that the flow capacity for any single load or chiller connection cannot exceed the flow rate of the loop. Because the loads are in series, the cooling coils must be sized for higher entering water temperatures than are normally used.

Because of its reduced installed and operating costs (Bahnfleth and Peyer 2004), the **variable primary flow** chilled-water system (Figure 37) is used more often today. One set of pumps with variable-speed drives moves water through both the chillers and the system. A bypass line with a control valve is used to maintain chiller minimum flow rates. Use care during sequencing to ensure proper flow transition and the chiller unit control's ability to keep the chiller online during the transition.

2.8 DUAL-TEMPERATURE SYSTEMS

Dual-temperature systems are used when the same load devices and distribution systems are used for both heating and cooling (e.g., fan-coil units and central station air-handling unit coils). In dual-temperature system design, the cooling cycle design usually dictates the requirements of the load heat exchangers and distribution systems. Dual-temperature systems are basically of three different configurations, each requiring different design techniques:

- Two-pipe systems

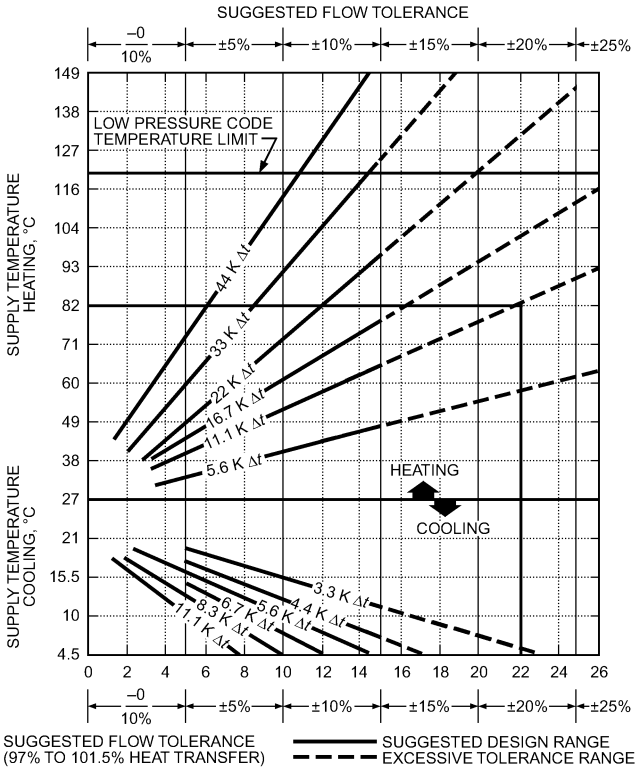

Fig. 34 Recommendations for Coil Flow Tolerance to Maintain 97% Design Heat Transfer

(Carlson 1981)

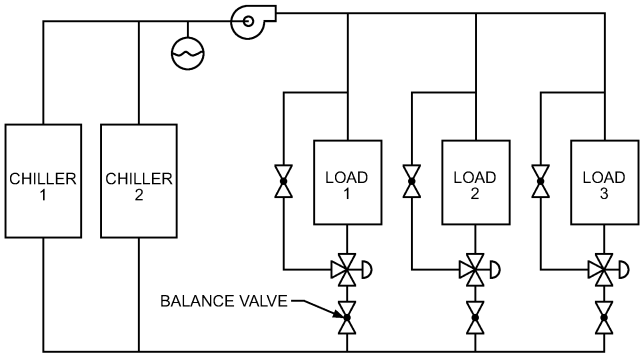

Fig. 35 Constant-Flow Chilled-Water System

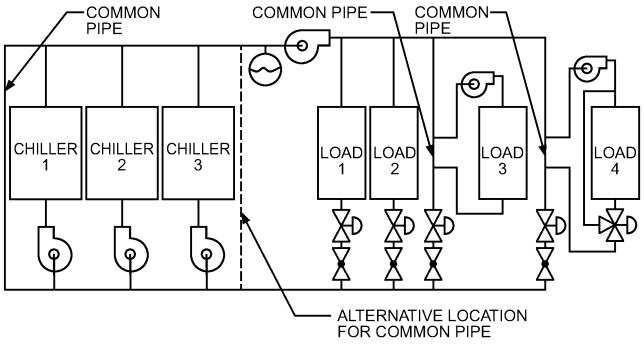

Fig. 36 Variable-Flow Chilled-Water System

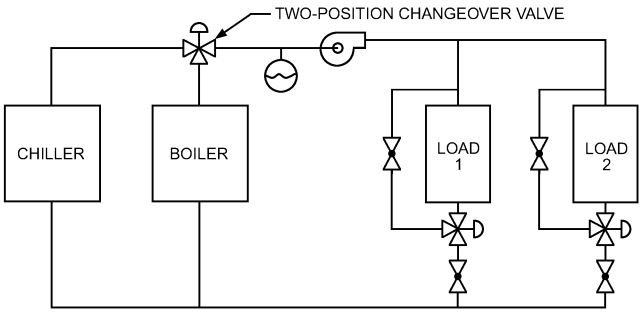

Fig. 37 Simplified Diagram of Two-Pipe System

- Four-pipe common load systems
- Four-pipe independent load systems

Two-Pipe Systems

In a dual-temperature two-pipe system, the load devices and the distribution system circulate chilled water when cooling is required and hot water when heating is required (Figure 37). Design considerations for these systems include the following:

- Loads must all require cooling or heating coincidentally; that is, if cooling is required for some loads and heating for other loads at a given time, this type of system should not be used.
- When designing the system, flow and temperature requirements for both cooling and heating media must be calculated first. The load and distribution system should be designed for the more stringent, and water temperatures and temperature differential should be calculated for the less stringent.
- Changeover should be designed such that the chiller evaporator is not exposed to damaging high water temperatures and the boiler is not subjected to damaging low water temperatures. To accommodate these limiting requirements, changeover of a system from one mode to the other requires considerable time. If rapid load swings are anticipated, a two-pipe system should not be selected, although it is the least costly of the three options.

Two-Pipe Dual-Temperature Chilled-Water Systems. Some cooling systems use two chilled-water temperatures: one for an air handler dedicated to treating outdoor air, and the other to satisfy sensible-cooling terminal units. One method to supply the two temperatures is to mix chilled water with return water from the terminal units; this keeps the supply chilled-water temperature to the sensible-cooling terminal units above the space dew point to prevent condensation on the terminal unit coil or surface (for radiant systems). Figure 38 shows a method to achieve the two temperatures.

To increase efficiency, some projects use different chillers: one for the outdoor air unit (at a lower design temperature), and the other for the terminal units (at a higher water temperature). Figure 39 shows one way to design such a system, with a third chiller that can operate at either the lower or elevated chilled-water design temperature to provide redundancy.

Four-Pipe Common Load Systems

In the four-pipe common load system, load devices are used for both heating and cooling as in the two-pipe system. The four-pipe common load system differs from the two-pipe system in that both heating and cooling are available to each load device, and changeover from one mode to the other takes place at each individual load device, or grouping of load devices, rather than at the source. Thus, some load systems can be in cooling mode while others are in heating mode. Figure 40 is a flow diagram of a four-pipe common load system, with multiple loads and a single boiler and chiller.

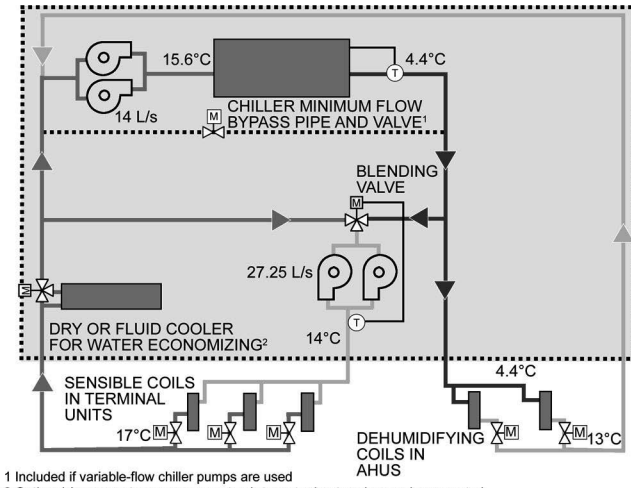

Fig. 38 Dual-Temperature Chilled-Water Systems Using Sources with Different Design Chilled-Water Temperatures

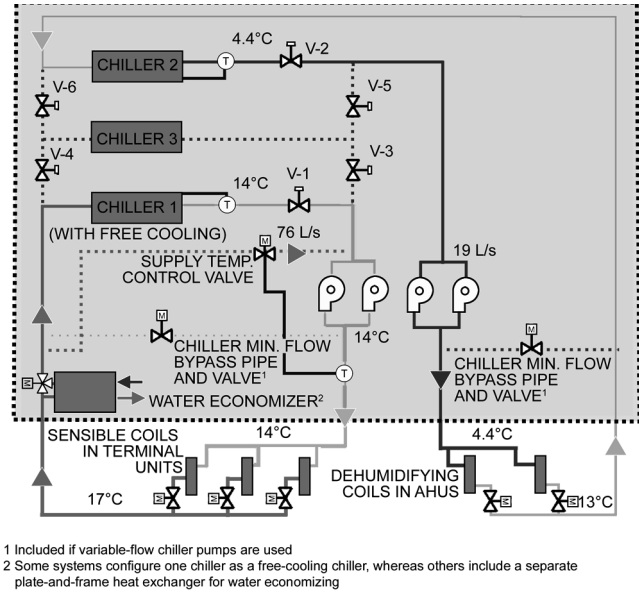

Fig. 39 Dual-Temperature Chilled-Water System Using Three Chillers

Four-Pipe Independent Load Systems

The four-pipe independent load system is preferred for hydronic applications in which some loads are in heating mode while others are in cooling mode. Control is simpler and more reliable than for the common load systems and, in many applications, this system is less costly to install. Also, flow through the individual loads can be modulated, providing both the control capability for variable capacity and the opportunity for variable flow in either or both circuits.

A simplified example of a four-pipe independent load system with two loads, one boiler, and two chillers is shown in Figure 41. Note that both hydronic circuits are essentially independent, so that each can be designed with disregard for the other system. Although both circuits in the figure are shown as variable-flow distribution

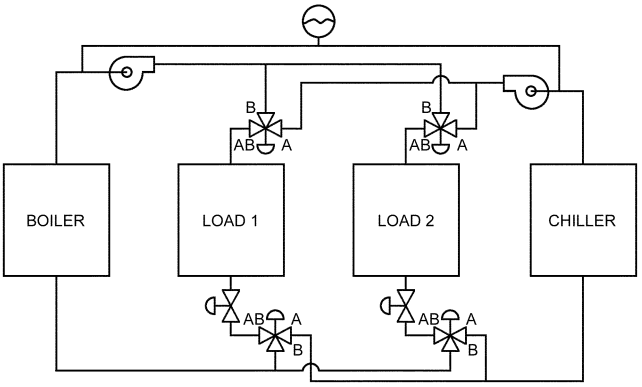

Fig. 40 Example Four-Pipe Common Load System

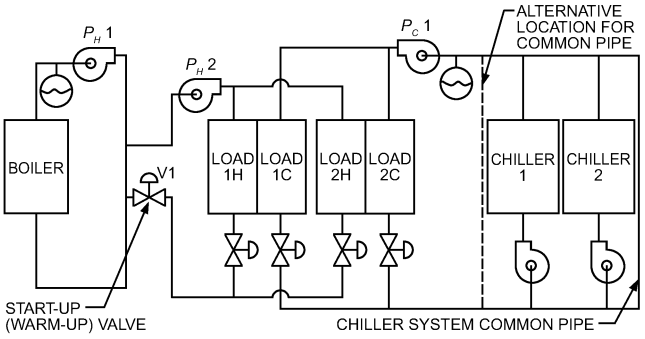

Fig. 41 Four-Pipe Independent Load System

systems, they could be constant-flow (three-way valves) or one variable and one constant. Generally, the control modulates the two load valves in sequence with a dead band at the control midpoint.

This type of system offers additional flexibility when some selective loads are arranged for heating only or cooling only, such as unit heaters or preheat coils. Then, central station systems can be designed for humidity control with reheat through configuration at the coil locations and with proper control sequences.

2.9 OTHER DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

Makeup and Fill Water Systems

Generally, a hydronic system is filled with water through a valved connection to a domestic water source, with a service valve, a backflow preventer, and a pressure gage. (The domestic water source pressure must exceed the system fill pressure.)

Because the expansion chamber is the reference pressure point in the system, the water makeup point is usually located at or near the expansion chamber.

Many designers prefer to install automatic makeup valves, which consist of a pressure-regulating valve in the makeup line. However, the quantity of water being made up must be monitored to avoid scaling and oxygen corrosion in the system.

Safety Relief Valves

Safety relief valves should be installed at any point at which pressures can be expected to exceed the safe limits of the system components. Causes of excessive pressures include

- Overpressurization from fill system
- Pressure increases caused by thermal expansion
- Surges caused by momentum changes (shock or water hammer)

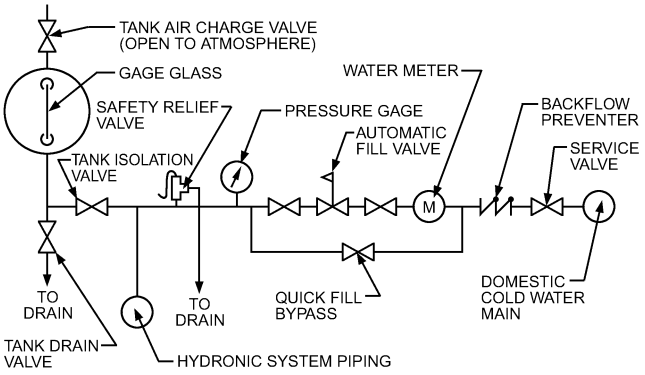

Fig. 42 Typical Makeup Water and Expansion Tank Piping Configuration for Plain Steel Expansion Tank

Overpressurization from the fill system could occur because of an accident in filling the system or the failure of an automatic fill regulator. To prevent this, a safety relief valve is usually installed at the fill location. Figure 42 shows a typical piping configuration for a system with a plain steel or air/water interface expansion tank. Note that no valves are installed between the hydronic system piping and the safety relief valve. This is a mandatory design requirement if the valve in this location is also to serve as a protection against pressure increases due to thermal expansion.

An expansion chamber is installed in a hydronic system, to allow for the volumetric changes that accompany water temperature changes. However, if any part of the system is configured such that it can be isolated from the expansion tank and its temperature can increase while it is isolated, then overpressure relief should be provided.

The relationship between pressure change caused by temperature change and the temperature change in a piping system is expressed by the following equation:

$$\Delta p = \frac{(\beta - 3\alpha)\Delta t}{(5/4)(D/E\,\Delta r) + \gamma} \tag{18}$$

where

Δp = pressure increase, kPa
β = volumetric coefficient of thermal expansion of water, K^{-1}
α = linear coefficient of thermal expansion for piping material, K^{-1}
Δt = water temperature increase, K
D = pipe diameter, mm
E = modulus of elasticity of piping material, kPa
γ = volumetric compressibility of water, m^2/kN
Δr = thickness of pipe wall, mm

Figure 43 shows a solution to Equation (18) demonstrating the pressure increase caused by any given temperature increase for 25 mm and 250 mm steel piping. If the temperature in a chilled-water system with piping spanning sizes between 25 and 250 mm were to increase by 10 K, the pressure would increase between 2.8 and 3.4 MPa, depending on the average pipe size in the system.

Safety relief should be provided to protect boilers, heat exchangers, cooling coils, chillers, and the entire system when the expansion tank is isolated for air charging or other service. As a minimum, the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* requires that a dedicated safety relief valve be installed on each boiler and that isolating or service valves be provided on the supply and return connections to each boiler.

Potential forces caused by shock waves or water hammer should also be considered in design. Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* discusses the causes of shock forces and the methodology for calculating the magnitude of these forces.

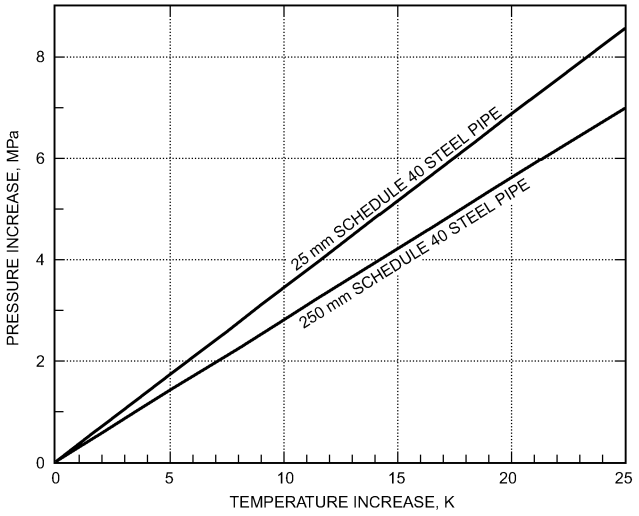

Fig. 43 Pressure Increase Resulting from Thermal Expansion as Function of Temperature Increase

Air Elimination

If air and other gases are not eliminated from the flow circuit, they may slow or stop the flow through the terminal heat transfer elements and cause corrosion, noise, reduced pumping capacity, and loss of hydraulic stability (see the section on Principles at the beginning of the chapter). A closed tank without a diaphragm can be installed at the point of the lowest solubility of air in water. With a diaphragm tank, air in the system can be removed by an air separator and air elimination valve installed at the point of lowest solubility. This type of system is called an air elimination system. Install manual vents at high points to remove all air trapped during initial operation. Include shutoff valves on any automatic air removal device to allow servicing without draining the system.

Air elimination devices are most effective at low velocities. Thus, the pipe leading up to the air elimination device often is smaller than the device piping, and this size difference should be accounted for in the design. Alternatively, with variable-speed pumping systems, the air elimination device could be commissioned at a flow rate less than full design flow, allowing for a lower entering velocity to the device. After commissioning, when air has been purged from the system, the device can be operated at the higher flow. This is less effective for air removal, but air is unlikely to reenter the closed-loop pumping system.

Standard steel vessels used as system compression tanks are air management systems. An air separator installed at the point of lowest solubility collects air recovered from the system and transfers it to the compression tank. The tank must have a monolithic tank fitting, allowing water and air to enter and leave the tank, and preventing gravity flow between the system and the tank. Automatic air removal devices should never be used in these systems, because collected system air provides the gas cushion for water system expansion and contraction.

Drain and Shutoff

All low points should have drains. Separate shutoff and draining of individual equipment and circuits should be possible so that the entire system does not have to be drained to service a particular item. Whenever a device or section of the system is isolated and water in that section or device could increase in temperature following isolation, overpressure safety relief protection must be provided.

Balance Fittings

Balance fittings or valves and a means of measuring flow quantity should be applied as needed to allow balancing of individual terminals and subcircuits. Balance, however, cannot be achieved through fittings or devices alone. In a balanced system, at design flow conditions, all terminals receive at least enough flow to create the required design heat transfer. Carlson (1968, 1981) suggested that 97% heat transfer was a reasonable value for required heat transfer accuracy, implying a flow tolerance to the coil based on heat transfer. On a 93°C entering water temperature (EWT) hot-water coil with a 11 K Δt, flow could be ±25% to the coil, and the required heat transfer would be achieved. However, as Δt and coil EWT increase, this flow tolerance decreases. Carlson suggested that, for system efficiency, circuits should be balanced to ±10% flow, which is commonly accepted. However, Carlson also noted that some systems have tighter flow tolerance (±5% or, in some cases, +10% and 0%), particularly where the log mean temperature difference (LMTD) of the coil is limited (e.g., in chilled-water systems) and flow tolerance becomes an issue in proper system operation. One method Carlson suggested to overcome these issues in constant-speed pumping systems was to use a branch-to-riser pressure drop ratio as a criterion for selecting distribution system friction loss. A 4:1 ratio allowed 95% of design flow to always reach the terminal, a 2:1 ratio yielded 90% flow, and 1:1 yielded 80% flow. In variable-speed pumping systems, this concept is helpful to analyze, but yields different results. Regardless, system distribution piping losses should be analyzed with respect to their effects on system flow, balance, and control valve operation, which leads to control stability. Using flow measurement fittings requires stabilized pipe flow, and is affected by the location and planar geometry of the device to fittings both up- and downstream. In general, allow reasonable straight pipe lengths (anything from a few pipe diameters to 20 diameters) before flow-measurement devices.

Pitch

Piping need not pitch but can run level, providing that flow velocities exceeding 0.45 m/s are maintained or a diaphragm tank is used.

Strainers

Strainers should be used where necessary to protect system elements, and sparingly to enhance energy efficiency. Carefully check strainers in the pump suction to avoid pump cavitation. Consider strainer designs that can trap particles during the commissioning (flush and clean) phase, and allow more particle trap size modification after commissioning, to reduce system pressure loss. Large separating chambers can serve as main air venting points and dirt strainers ahead of pumps. Automatic control valves or other devices operating with small clearances require protection from pipe scale, gravel, and welding slag, which may readily pass through the pump and its protective separator. Individual fine mesh strainers may therefore be required ahead of each control valve. An alternative is to use two manual three-way valves entering a coil with connected bypasses. During commissioning, isolate all coils from the system, with the three-way valve bypasses connected, allowing flushing water to serve main distribution piping to the coil but not carrying particulates through the coil. After piping is flushed and cleaned, position the valves to allow flow to and from the coil. This method removes most system particulates, thus protecting the coil, and, if individual coil strainers are used, greatly reduces labor in flushing each individual strainer.

Thermometers

Thermometers or thermometer wells should be installed to assist the system operator in routine operation and troubleshooting. Permanent thermometers, with the correct scale range and separate

sockets, should be used at all points where temperature readings are regularly needed. Install thermometer wells where readings will be needed only during start-up and infrequent troubleshooting. If a central monitoring system is provided, locate a calibration well adjacent to each sensing point in insulated piping systems.

Flexible Connectors and Pipe Expansion Compensation

Flexible connectors are sometimes installed at pumps and machinery to reduce pipe stress. See Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for vibration isolation information. Piping systems should be supported independently of flexible connections.

Gage Cocks

Gage cocks or quick-disconnect test ports should be installed at points requiring pressure or temperature readings. Gages permanently installed in the system will deteriorate because of vibration and pulsation and may become unreliable. It is good practice to install gage cocks and provide the operator with several high-quality gages for diagnostic purposes. Avoid overuse of gage cocks and test ports, because they represent points of potential system leakage. In general, one port entering and leaving the coil is adequate, and can be combined with other functions to produce data required to verify system operation.

Insulation

Insulation should be applied to minimize pipe thermal loss and to prevent condensation during chilled-water operation (see Chapter 23 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). Comply with the minimum requirements of ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1. On chilled-water systems, install special rigid metal sleeves or shields at all hanger and support points, and provide all valves with extended bonnets to allow for the full insulation thickness without interference with the valve operators.

Condensate Drains

Condensate drains from dehumidifying coils should be trapped and piped to an open-sight plumbing drain. Traps should be deep enough to overcome the air pressure differential between drain inlet and room, which ordinarily will not exceed 500 Pa. Pipe should be noncorrosive and insulated to prevent moisture condensation. Depending on the quantity and temperature of condensate, plumbing drain lines may require insulation to prevent sweating.

Common Pipe

In compound (primary/secondary) pumping systems, the common pipe is used to dynamically decouple the two pumping circuits. Ideally, there is no pressure drop in this section of piping; however, in actual systems, it is recommended that this section of piping be a minimum of 10 diameters long to reduce the likelihood of unwanted mixing resulting from velocity (kinetic) energy or turbulence.

2.10 OTHER DESIGN PROCEDURES

Preliminary Equipment Layout

Flows in Mains and Laterals. Regardless of the method used to determine the flow through each item of terminal equipment, the desired result should be listed on the preliminary plans or in a schedule of flow rates for the piping system.

In an equipment schedule or on the plans, starting from the most remote terminal and working toward the pump, progressively list the cumulative flow and pressure loss in each of the mains and branch circuits in the distribution system. It is helpful in system commissioning to have a piping system schematic noting the friction loss calculations of each flow path. This should be included with the design drawings of the project.

The designer is responsible for selecting control valves and coordinating them with heat transfer devices. A schedule of devices and detailed connection schematic should be given.

Preliminary Pipe Sizing. For each portion of the piping circuit, select a tentative pipe size from the unified flow chart (Figures 14 to 16 in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*), using a value of pipe friction loss ranging from 80 to 450 Pa per metre of straight pipe. Velocity through the pipe should not exceed 3 m/s in general application. Air management techniques suggest that velocity should also be kept above 0.6 m/s, so entrained air is carried through the system, although piping layout considerations may make this less of an issue. The copper piping trade association suggests establishing maximum velocities of 1.5 m/s for hot-water piping and 2.4 m/s for cold-water piping (CDA 2006). Others suggest that no greater than 1.2 m/s be used on pipes less than 38 mm in diameter. Other suggestions are in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 provides maximum flow rates for pipe sizes, depending on the chilled-water system type and operation.

Residential piping size is often based on pump preselection using pipe sizing tables, which are available from the Hydronics Institute or from manufacturers. Allow adequate space for water entrance to pump volute, to reduce pump suction losses in manifolds.

Preliminary Pressure Drop. Using the preliminary pipe sizing, determine the pressure drop through each portion of piping. The total pressure drop in the longest circuits determines the maximum pressure drop through the piping, including the terminals and control valves, that must be available in the form of pump pressure.

Preliminary Pump Selection. The preliminary selection should be based on the pump's ability to fulfill the determined capacity requirements. It should be selected as close as possible to best efficiency on the pump curve and should not overload the motor. Because pressure drop in a flow system varies as the square of the flow rate, the flow variation between the nearest size of stock pump and an exact point selection will be relatively minor. Note that, although efficiency is important, it is secondary to the pipe sizing criteria. Proper pipe sizing reduces overall pressure losses, allowing a lower-power pump to be used for the same flow rate, and should be considered first.

Final Pipe Sizing and Pressure Drop Determination

Final Piping Layout. Examine the overall piping layout to determine whether pipe sizes in some areas need to be readjusted. Several principal circuits should have approximately equal pressure drops so that excessive pressures are not needed to serve a small portion of the building.

Consider both the initial cost of the pump and piping system and the pump's operating cost when determining final system friction loss. Generally, lower pressure and larger piping are more economical when longer amortization periods are considered, especially in larger systems. However, in small systems such as in residences, it may be most economical to select the pump first and design the piping system to meet the available pressure. In all cases, adjust the piping system design and pump selection until the optimum design is found.

Final Pressure Drop. When the final piping layout has been established, determine the friction loss for each section of the piping system from the pressure drop charts (Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*) for the mass flow rate in each portion of the piping system.

After calculating friction loss at design flow for all sections of the piping system and all fittings, terminal units, and control valves, sum them for several of the longest piping circuits to determine the pressure against which the pump must operate at design flow.

Final Pump Selection. After completing the final pressure drop calculations, select the pump by plotting a system curve and pump

curve and selecting the pump or pump assembly that operates closest to the calculated design point.

Freeze Prevention

In all locations that experience freezing temperatures, circulating water systems require precautions to prevent freezing, particularly in makeup air applications in temperate climates where (1) coils are exposed to outdoor air at freezing temperatures, (2) undrained chilled-water coils are in the winter airstream, or (3) piping passes through unheated spaces. Freezing will not occur as long as flow is maintained and the water is at least warm. Unfortunately, during extremely cold weather or in the event of a power failure, water flow and temperature cannot be guaranteed. Additionally, continuous pumping can be energy intensive and cause system wear. The following precautions can help avoid flow stoppage or damage from freezing:

- Select all load devices (such as preheat coils) subjected to outdoor air temperatures for constant-flow, variable-Δt control.
- Position the coil valves of all cooling coils with valve control that are dormant in winter to the full-open position at those times.
- If intermittent pump operation is used as an economy measure, use an automatic override to operate both chilled- and heating-water pumps in below-freezing weather.
- Select pump starters that automatically restart after power failure (i.e., maintain-contact control).
- Select nonoverloading pumps.
- Instruct operating personnel never to shut down pumps in subfreezing weather.
- Do not use aquastats, which can stop a pump, in boiler circuits.
- Avoid sluggish circulation, which may cause air binding or dirt deposit. Properly balance and clean systems. Provide proper air control or means to eliminate air.
- Install low-temperature-detection thermostats that have phase change capillaries wound in a serpentine pattern across the leaving face of the upstream coil.

In fan equipment handling outdoor air, take precautions to avoid stratification of air entering the coil. The best methods for mixing indoor and outdoor air are the following:

- Select dampers for pressure drops adequate to provide stable control of mixing, preferably with dampers installed several equivalent diameters upstream of the air-handling unit.
- Design intake and approach duct systems to promote natural mixing.
- Select coils with circuiting to allow parallel flow of air and water.

Freeze-up may still occur with any of these precautions. If an antifreeze solution is not used, water should circulate at all times when outdoor temperatures near the freezing point. Valve-controlled elements should have low-limit thermostats, and sensing elements should be located to ensure accurate air temperature readings. Primary/secondary pumping of coils with three-way valve injection (as in Figures 29B and 29C) is advantageous. Use outdoor reset of water temperature wherever possible.

2.11 ANTIFREEZE SOLUTIONS

In systems in danger of freeze-up, water solutions of ethylene glycol and propylene glycol are commonly used. Freeze protection may be needed (1) in snow-melting applications (see Chapter 52 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*); (2) in systems subjected to 100% outdoor air, where the methods outlined in the section on Freeze Protection may not provide absolute antifreeze protection; (3) in isolated parts or zones of a heating system where intermittent operation or long runs of exposed piping increase the danger of freezing; and (4) in process cooling applications requiring temperatures below 4°C. Although using ethylene glycol or propylene glycol is comparatively expensive and tends to create corrosion problems unless suitable inhibitors are used, it may be the only practical solution in many cases.

Solutions of triethylene glycol, as well as certain other heat transfer fluids, may also be used. However, ethylene glycol and propylene glycol are the most common substances used in hydronic systems because they are less costly and provide the most effective heat transfer.

Effect on Heat Transfer and Flow

Tables 6 to 13 and Figures 9 to 16 in Chapter 31 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* show density, specific heat, thermal conductivity, and viscosity of various aqueous solutions of ethylene glycol and propylene glycol. Tables 4 and 5 of that chapter indicate the freezing points for the two solutions.

System heat transfer rate is affected by relative density and specific heat according to the following equation:

$$q_w = Q \rho c_p \Delta t \tag{19}$$

where

q_w = total heat transfer rate, W
Q = flow rate, L/s
ρ = fluid density, kg/m^3
c_p = specific heat of fluid, kJ/(kg·K)
Δt = temperature increase or decrease, K

Effect on Heat Source or Chiller

Generally, ethylene glycol solutions should not be used directly in a boiler because of the danger of chemical corrosion caused by glycol breakdown on direct heating surfaces. However, properly inhibited glycol solutions can be used in low-temperature water systems directly in the heating boiler if proper operation can be ensured. Automobile antifreeze solutions are not recommended because the silicate inhibitor can cause fouling, pump seal wear, fluid gelation, and reduced heat transfer. The area or zone requiring antifreeze protection can be isolated with a separate heat exchanger or converter. Glycol solutions are used directly in water chillers in many cases.

Glycol solutions affect the output of a heat exchanger by changing the film coefficient of the surface contacting the solution. This change in film coefficient is caused primarily by viscosity changes. Figure 44 shows typical changes in output for two types of heat exchangers, a steam-to-liquid converter and a refrigerant-to-liquid chiller. The curves are plotted for one set of operating conditions only and reflect the change in ethylene glycol concentration as the

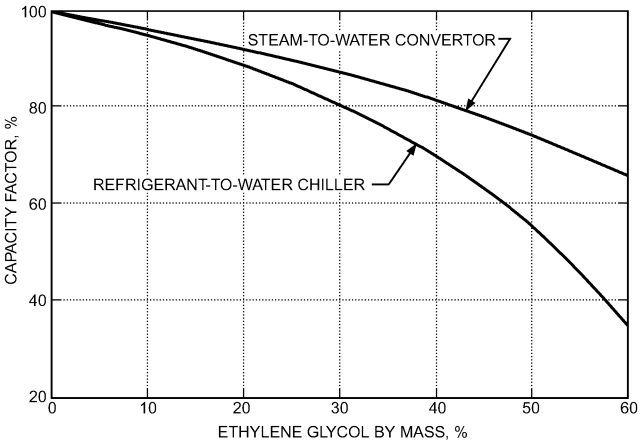

Fig. 44 Example of Effect of Aqueous Ethylene Glycol Solutions on Heat Exchanger Output

only variable. Propylene glycol has a similar effect on heat exchanger output.

Because many other variables (e.g., liquid velocity, steam or refrigerant loading, temperature difference, unit construction) affect a heat exchanger's overall coefficient, designers should consult manufacturers' ratings when selecting such equipment. The curves indicate only the magnitude of these output changes.

Effect on Terminal Units

Heat transfer capability can change by 40% or more when antifreeze solutions are used. Because the effect of glycol on the capacity of terminal units may vary widely with temperature, consult the manufacturer's rating data when selecting heating or cooling units in glycol systems.

Effect on Pump Performance

Centrifugal pump characteristics are affected to some degree by glycol solutions because of viscosity changes. Figure 45 shows these effects on pump capacity, pressure, and efficiency. Figures 12 and 16 in Chapter 31 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* plot the viscosity of aqueous ethylene glycol and propylene glycol. Centrifugal pump performance is normally cataloged for water at 15 to 25°C. Hence, absolute viscosity effects below 1.1 mPa·s can safely be ignored as far as pump performance is concerned. In intermittently operated systems, such as snow-melting applications, viscosity effects at start-up may decrease flow enough to slow pickup.

Effect on Piping Pressure Loss

Friction loss in piping also varies with viscosity changes. Figure 46 gives correction factors for various ethylene glycol and propylene glycol solutions. These factors are applied to the calculated pressure loss for water (Equation [18]). No correction is needed for ethylene glycol and propylene glycol solutions above 70°C.

Installation and Maintenance

Because glycol solutions are comparatively expensive, use the smallest possible concentrations to produce the desired antifreeze properties. Carefully calculate the system's total water content to determine the required amount of glycol (Craig et al. 1993). The solution can be mixed outside the system in drums or barrels and then pumped in. Watch air vents during filling to prevent loss of solution. The system and cold-water supply should not be permanently connected, so automatic fill valves are usually not used.

Ethylene glycol and propylene glycol normally include an inhibitor to help prevent corrosion. Check solutions each year using a suitable refractometer to determine glycol concentration. Take the following precautions regarding the use of inhibited ethylene glycol solutions to extend their service life and to preserve equipment:

- Before injecting the glycol solution, thoroughly clean and flush the system.
- Use waters that are soft and low in chloride and sulfate ions to prepare the solution whenever possible.
- Limit the maximum operating temperature to 120°C in a closed hydronic system. In a heat exchanger, limit glycol film temperatures to 150 to 175°C (steam pressures 830 kPa or less) to prevent deterioration of the solution.
- Check the concentration of inhibitor periodically, following procedures recommended by the glycol manufacturer.

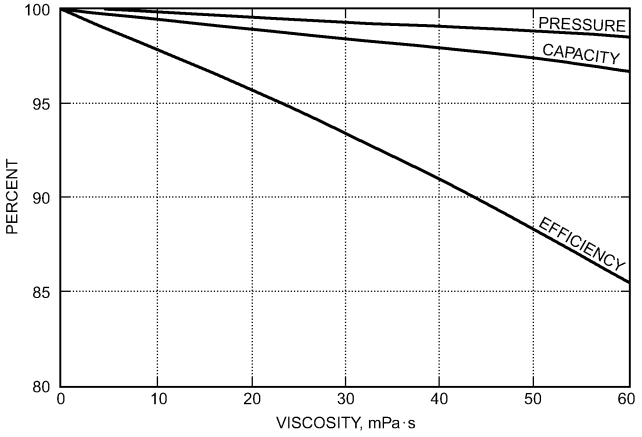

Fig. 45 Effect of Viscosity on Pump Characteristics

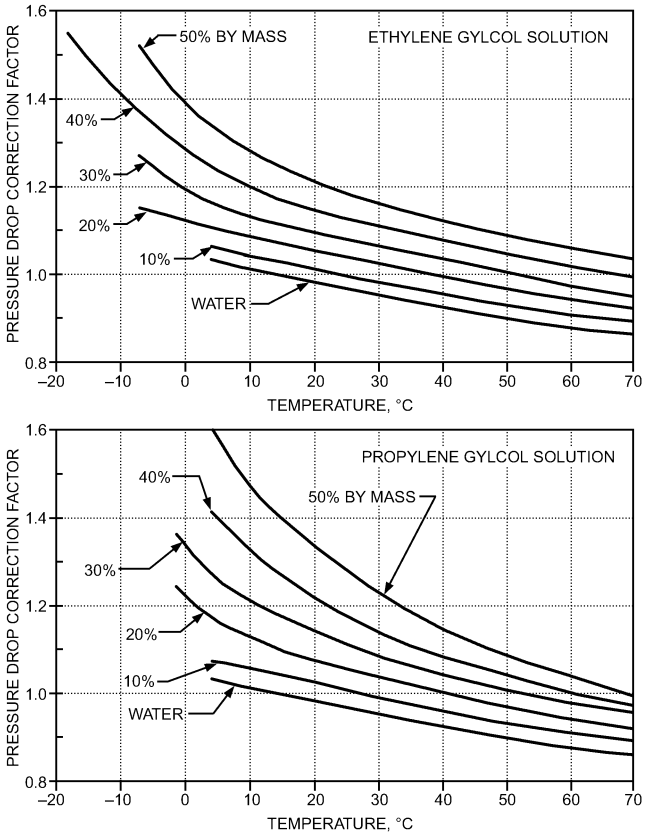

Fig. 46 Pressure Drop Correction for Glycol Solutions

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CHAPTER 14

CONDENSER WATER SYSTEMS

Once-Through City Water Systems 14.1
Open Cooling Tower Systems 14.1
Low-Temperature (Water Economizer) Systems 14.4
Closed-Circuit Evaporative Coolers 14.4
Other Sources of Water 14.4
Overpressure Caused by Thermal Fluid Expansion 14.4

As part of the vapor-compression cycle for mechanical refrigeration, the heat of compression produced must be rejected to complete the refrigeration cycle. Refrigerant systems may be cooled by air or water. In water-cooled systems, water flows through the condenser and is called **condenser water**. Condenser water systems are classified as (1) once-through systems (e.g., city water, well-water, or lake/groundwater systems), or (2) recirculating or cooling tower systems. This chapter focuses on open condenser water systems and evaporative coolers; for information on closed-loop systems used in ground-source heat pump loops, see Chapter 49 of this volume and Chapter 35 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

1. ONCE-THROUGH CITY WATER SYSTEMS

Once-through city water systems use water from the city's potable water supply and circulate through the refrigeration equipment condenser (e.g., walk-in cooler, computer room unit) to reject heat and discharge water directly to the sewer. Many municipalities prohibit this type of direct water cooling because of water conservation restrictions, although some localities allow its use as a standby or emergency condenser water system for critical refrigeration needs such as for computer rooms, research laboratories, or critical operating room or life support machinery. In addition, standards such as ASHRAE *Standard* 189.1 do not allow once-through city water for heat rejection. If city water is allowed for condenser water purposes, then allowed flow may be limited to less than 3.5 mL/s per kilowatt of cooling. The designer should contact the local water department to determine the viability of this system.

Figure 1 shows a water-cooled condenser using city water. The return (leaving water) piping is routed at a higher elevation than the condenser so that the condenser is always full of water. Water flow through the condenser is regulated by a control valve in the supply or discharge line, usually actuated from condenser head pressure to (1) maintain a constant condensing temperature with load variations and (2) close when the refrigeration compressor turns off. City water systems should always include approved backflow prevention devices and open (air gap) drains. When more than one condenser is used on the same circuit, use individual control valves.

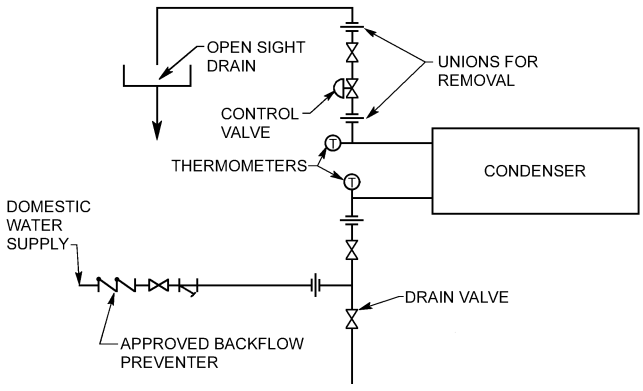

Fig. 1 Condenser Connections for Once-Through City Water System

Piping materials for these systems are generally nonferrous, usually copper but sometimes high-pressure plastic, because corrosion-protective chemicals cannot be used. Scaling can be a problem with higher-temperature condensing surfaces when the water has a relatively high calcium content. In these applications, use mechanically cleanable straight tubes in the condenser.

Piping should be sized according to the principles outlined in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, with velocities of 1.5 to 3 m/s for design flow rates. A pump is usually not required where city water is used. **Well water** can be used in lieu of city water, connected on the service side of the pumping/pressure control system. Because most well water has high calcium content, scaling on the condenser surfaces can be a problem.

Another once-through system uses lake or river water. Although these systems eliminate the need for a cooling tower, they require particular attention to filtering out sediment, particulates, and other materials that could foul the system. In the United States, special permitting is required from the local Department of Natural Resources (DNR) and the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). Particular attention must be paid to the design of intake structures and keeping the velocity below 1.5 m/s so as not to intake aquatic wildlife. Local disturbances or seasonal weather conditions can cause lake or river water elevations to fluctuate, so ensure that the system uses proper safeguards or vacuum priming systems as required.

2. OPEN COOLING TOWER SYSTEMS

Open systems have at least two points of interface between the system water and the atmosphere; they require a different approach to hydraulic design, pump selection, and sizing than do closed hot- and chilled-water systems. Some heat conservation systems rely on a split condenser heating system that includes a two-section condenser. One section of the condenser supplies heat for closed-circuit heating or reheat systems; the other section serves as a heat rejection circuit, which is an open system connected to a cooling tower (see Chapter 40).

In selecting a pump for a cooling tower/condenser water system, consider the static pressure and the system friction loss. The pump inlet must have an adequate net positive suction pressure (see Chapter 40). In addition, continuous contact with air introduces oxygen into the water and concentrates minerals that can cause scale and corrosion on a continuing basis. Fouling factors and an increased pressure drop caused by aging of the piping must be taken into account in the condenser piping system design (see Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). Corrosion and erosion are not just limited to condenser water piping: the chiller condenser water bundle sees the same water. It is not uncommon to coat the condenser water box with epoxy paint or other material to prolong its life. Similarly, adding nylon tube inserts extends the life of the tube ends at the tube sheet walls.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.1, Hydronic and Steam Equipment and Systems.

The required water flow rate depends on the refrigeration unit used and on the temperature of the available condenser water. Cooling tower water is available for return to the condenser at a temperature several degrees above the design wet-bulb temperature, depending on tower performance. An approach of 4 K to the design wet-bulb temperature is frequently considered an economically sound design. In city, lake, river, or well water systems, the maximum water temperature that occurs during the operating season must be used for equipment selection and design flow rates and temperature ranges.

The required flow rate through a condenser may be determined with manufacturers' performance data for various condensing temperatures and capacities. With air-conditioning refrigeration applications, a return or leaving condenser water temperature of 35°C has been standard practice. If economic feasibility analyses can justify it, higher leaving-water temperatures (and lower condenser flow rates) may be beneficial to the chilled-water system.

Figure 2 shows a typical cooling tower system for a refrigerant condenser. Water flows to the pump from the tower basin or sump and is discharged under pressure to the condenser and then back to the tower. When it is desirable to control condenser water temperature or maintain it above a predetermined minimum, water is diverted through a control valve directly back to the tower basin. (preferred method). The alternative bypass option shown in Figure 2 is not recommended because it does not keep the basin water circulating and warm, and thus allows possible freezing of water in the basin and exposed piping, even if the piping is insulated and the basin heated. Full flow is desired in the bypass piping, because reduced flow may increase the risk of freezing.

Piping from the tower sump to the pump requires some precautions because, at this point, the water is basically flowing due to gravity. The sump level should be above the top of the pump casing for positive prime, and piping pressure drop should be minimized such that there is always adequate net positive suction pressure (NPSP) on the pump. Not having adequate NPSP leads to pump cavitation and potential damage to the pump impeller, thereby requiring close attention, accurate pressure calculation, and appropriate pump selections, as discussed in the following sections. All piping must pitch up to the tower basin, if possible, to eliminate air pockets. It is not unusual to have this piping a diameter or two larger than the pump discharge or pressurized piping.

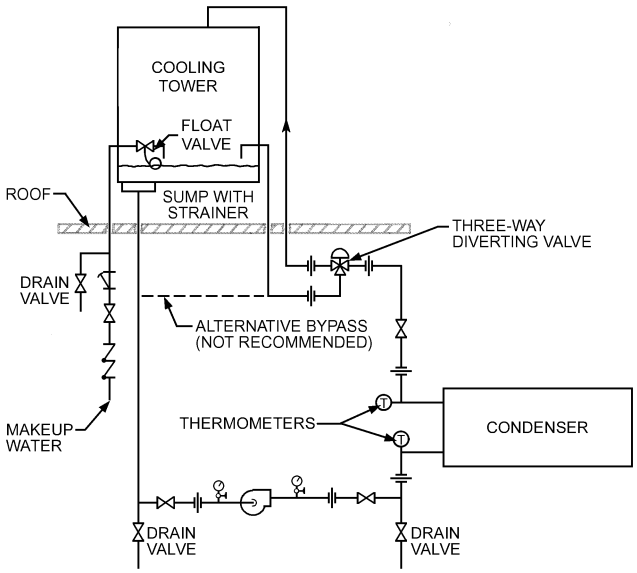

Fig. 2 Cooling Tower Piping System

If used, suction strainers should be equipped with inlet and outlet gages to indicate through excessive pressure drop when cleaning is required. In-line pipe strainers are not recommended for cooling tower systems because they tend to become blocked and turn into a reliability problem in themselves. Many designers depend on large mesh screens in the tower sump and condenser heads designed with settling basins to remove particulate matter. If a strainer is deemed necessary, two-large capacity basket strainers, installed in parallel such that they can be alternately put into service and valved out for cleaning, are recommended.

Air and Vapor Precautions

Both vapor and air can create serious problems in open cooling tower systems. Water vaporizes in the pump impeller if adequate net positive suction pressure is not available. When this occurs, the pump loses capacity, and serious damage to the impeller can result. Equally damaging **vaporization** can occur in other portions of the system where pressure in the pipe can drop below the vapor pressure at the operating water temperature. On shutdown, these very low pressures can result from a combination of static pressure and momentum. Vaporization is often followed by an implosion, which causes destructive water hammer. To avoid this problem, keep all sections of the piping system except the return line to the upper tower basin below the basin level. When this cannot be achieved, perform a thorough dynamic analysis of the piping system for all operating conditions; a soft start and stop control such as a variable-frequency drive on the pump motor is recommended as an additional precaution, and all actuated control valves should be slow closing.

Air release is another characteristic of open condenser water systems that must be addressed. Because the water/air solution in the tower basin is saturated at atmospheric pressure and cold-water basin temperature, the system should be designed to maintain the pressure at all points in the system sufficiently above atmospheric that no air will be released in the condenser or in the piping system (see Figures 2 and 3 in Chapter 13).

Another cause of air in the piping system is **vortexing** at the tower basin outlet. This can be avoided by ensuring that the maximum flow does not exceed that recommended by the tower manufacturer. Release of air in condenser water systems is the major cause of corrosion, and it causes decreased pump flow (similar to cavitation), water flow restrictions in some piping sections, and possible water hammer. Antivortexing devices can be added to the piping to mitigate this occurrence. These features often are available on strainers and suction diffusers.

Pump Selection and Pressure Calculations

The elements of required pump pressure are illustrated in Figure 3. Because there is an equal pressure between the level in the tower sump or interior reservoir and the pump on both the suction and discharge sides, these static pressures cancel each other and can be disregarded.

The elements of pump pressure are (1) static pressure from tower sump or interior reservoir level to the tower header, (2) friction loss in suction and discharge piping, (3) pressure loss in the condenser, (4) pressure loss in the control valves, (5) pressure loss in the strainer, and (6) pressure loss in the tower nozzles, if used. Added together, these elements determine the required pump total dynamic pressure.

Normally, piping is sized for water velocities between 1.5 and 3.6 m/s. As stated previously, piping on the discharge of the pump may see the higher velocities, and piping on the suction side should see the lower velocities. Refer to Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for piping system pressure losses. Friction factors for 15-year-old pipe are commonly used.

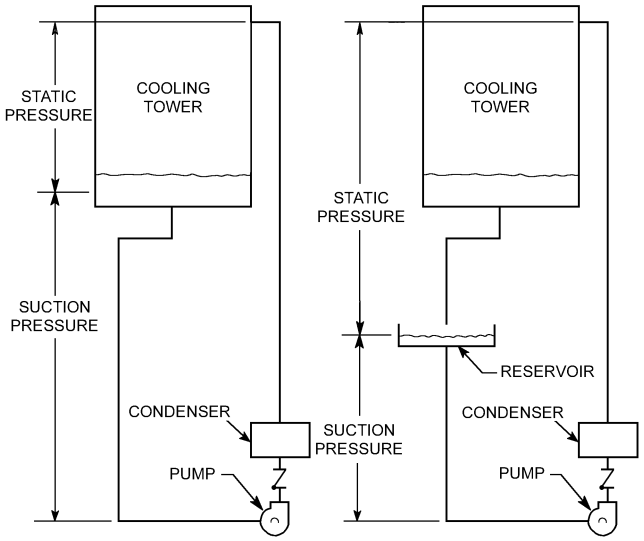

Fig. 3 Schematic Piping Layout Showing Static and Suction Pressure

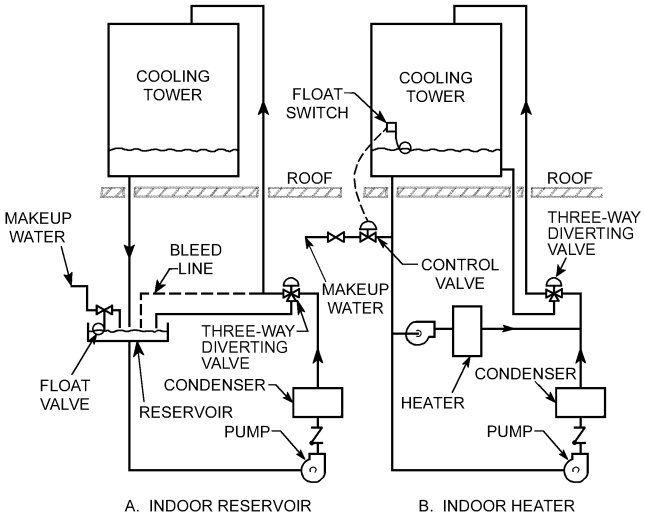

Fig. 4 Cooling Tower Piping to Avoid Freeze-Up

Manufacturers' data contain pressure drops for the condenser, cooling tower, control valves, and strainers.

If multiple cooling towers are to be connected, the piping should be designed so that the pressure loss from the tower to the pump suction is exactly equal for each tower. The basin water operating level should physically be at the same elevation, or the lower basin could overflow. Additionally, large equalizing lines or a common reservoir can be used to ensure this. However, for reliability, redundancy, and ease of maintenance, multiple basins are often preferred.

Evaporation in a cooling tower concentrates the dissolved solids in the circulating water. This concentration can be limited by discharging a portion of the water as overflow or blowdown, either by discharging or bleeding a continuous stream of water, or by using a conductivity sensor to activate blowdown valves in the system. An estimate of the bleed rate should equal the amount of evaporation occurring in the tower.

Makeup water is required to replace water lost by evaporation, blowdown, and drift. Automatic float valves or level controllers are usually installed to maintain a constant water level. If float valves are used, the control system should be tuned to desensitize the readings from turbulent, foaming water in the cooling tower basin. If a reservoir is used, the level devices may be installed in a "stilling" tube to read less-turbulent water levels.

Water Treatment

Water treatment is necessary to prevent scaling, corrosion, and biological fouling of the condenser and circulating system. The extent and nature of the treatment depends on the chemistry of the available water and on the system design characteristics. On large systems, fixed continuous-feeding chemical treatment systems are frequently installed in which chemicals, including acids for pH control, must be diluted and blended and then pumped into the condenser water system. Corrosion-resistant materials may be required for surfaces that come in contact with these chemicals. In piping system design, provisions for feeding the chemicals, blowdowns, drains, and testing must be included. Because cooling towers move great quantities of air and the water flow acts as an air washer, towers can introduce a great deal of airborne particulate into the basin and condenser water system. Therefore, side-stream filtration with separate pumping systems is recommended. For further information on water treatment, refer to Chapter 40 of this volume and Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Freeze Protection and Winter Operation

Outdoor piping must be protected (insulated and heat traced) or drained when a tower operates intermittently during cold weather. The most satisfactory arrangement is to provide an indoor reservoir tank into which the cold-water basin drains by gravity, as shown in Figure 4A. The makeup, overflow, and pump suction lines are then connected to the indoor reservoir tank rather than to the tower basin. This arrangement may also use vertical turbine pumps that save floor space compared to a base-mounted centrifugal pump. The indoor basin also serves as a settling basin for any waterborne particulate; thus, the basin should be drained or cleaned annually to avoid biological growth and potential fouling of the chiller's condenser surfaces. If the system is small, many cooling tower manufacturers have remote sump tanks as an option.

Size the reservoir or sump for the entire system water volume that drains back into the sump when the pumps deenergize. A common rule of thumb is to add the volume of water required if the condenser water pumps were to run for 3 min as a minimum level to have enough water to prime the piping system. The reservoirs should have high- and low-water alarms and makeup water level controls. Also consider the pump suction requirements to prevent vortexing to determine the depth. Because the pipe entering the sump also may contain great quantities of air, the sump should have a vent or open grate of adequate size.

For winter operation, consider using a condenser water bypass directly to the reservoir to prevent water that is too cold entering the condenser. Never operate a cooling tower in the winter without a heat load. If the tower has variable-frequency drives (VFDs), they should be modulated to keep the water temperature above freezing. Fan reversal for several minutes can be used for deicing, but must be discussed with the tower manufacturer to determine any limitations.

A control sequence for the piping arrangement of Figure 4A with rising water temperature would be as follows:

- A temperature sensor measures the temperature of water leaving the indoor sump.
- As the temperature starts to rise, the diverting valve begins directing some of the water over the tower.
- After the water is in full flow over the tower and the temperature continues to rise above set point, the fan is started on low speed,

with the speed increasing until the water temperature reaches set point.
- With falling water temperature, the opposite sequence occurs.

Tower basin heaters or heat exchangers connected across the supply and return line to the tower can also be selected. Steam or electric basin heaters are most commonly used. An arrangement incorporating an indoor heater is shown in Figure 4B.

3. LOW-TEMPERATURE (WATER ECONOMIZER) SYSTEMS

When open cooling tower systems are used for generating chilled water directly, through an indirect heat exchanger such as a plate-and-frame heat exchanger, or with a chiller thermocycle circuit, the bulk water temperature is such that icing can occur on or within the cooling tower, with destructive effects. The piping circuit precautions are similar to those described in the section on Open Cooling Tower Systems, but they are much more critical. For precautions in protecting cooling towers from icing damage, see Chapter 40.

Water from open cooling tower systems should not be piped directly through cooling coils, unitary heat pump condensers, or plate-and-frame heat exchangers unless the water is first filtered through a high-efficiency filtering system and the water treatment system is managed carefully to minimize the dissolved solids. Even with these precautions, cooling coils should have straight tubes arranged for visual inspection and mechanical cleaning, unitary heat pumps should be installed for easy removal and replacement, and plate-and-frame heat exchangers should be installed for ready accessibility for disassembly and cleaning.

ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1-2016 recommends an integrated or series configuration for water-side (fluid) economizers in chilled-water systems. Taylor (2014) is a good resource for fluid economizer designs.

4. CLOSED-CIRCUIT EVAPORATIVE COOLERS

Because of the potential for damaging freezing of cooling towers, some designers prefer to use closed-circuit evaporative/dry coolers for water economizer chilled-water systems. One of the many different configurations of these systems is shown in Figure 5. The open water is simply recirculated from the basin to the sprays of the evaporative cooler, and the cooling water system is a closed hydronic system usually using a glycol/water mixture for freeze protection (see Chapter 39). The open water system is then drained in freezing weather and the cooling heat exchanger unit is operated as a dry heat exchanger. This type of system in some configurations can be used to generate chilled water through the plate-and-frame heat exchanger shown or to remove heat from a closed heat pump circuit. The glycol circuit is generally not used directly either for building cooling or for the heat pump circuit because of the economic penalty of the glycol system. The closed circuit is designed in accordance with the principles and procedures described in Chapter 13.

5. OTHER SOURCES OF WATER

Often, potable water for cooling tower makeup is unavailable or too expensive to use, such as in the arid areas of the Middle East. Other fluids available for use in cooling towers include treated sewage effluent (TSE) and sea water. Both fluids require additional investigation of their effects on chiller condenser and cooling tower surfaces, because of increased fouling and corrosivity. When using either TSE or sea water, chiller condenser tubes are typically titanium or stainless steel and cooling tower fill is generally modified to a thicker material with stainless steel fasteners and noncorrosive

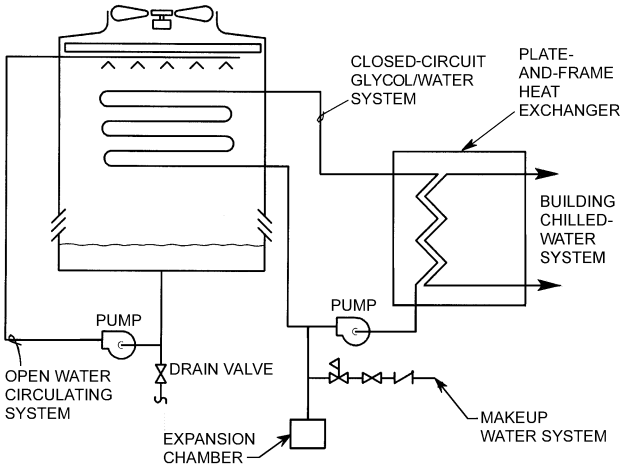

Fig. 5 Closed-Circuit Evaporative Cooler System

materials such as pultruded glass fiber. Consult the cooling tower and chiller vendors early in design for design direction, efficiency, and cost implications.

6. OVERPRESSURE CAUSED BY THERMAL FLUID EXPANSION

When open condenser water systems are used at low temperatures for winter cooling, special precautions should be taken to prevent damaging overpressurization caused by thermal expansion. This phenomenon has been known to cause severe damage when a section of piping containing water at a lower temperature than the surrounding space is isolated while cold. This isolation could be intentional, such as isolation by two service valves, or it could be as subtle as a section of piping isolated between a check valve and a control valve. If such an isolation occurs when water at 7°C is in a 25 mm pipe passing through a 24°C space, Figure 41 in Chapter 13 reveals that the pressure would increase by 5.8 MPa, which would be destructive to many components of most condenser water systems. Refer to the section on Other Design Considerations in Chapter 13 for a discussion of this phenomenon.

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CHAPTER 15

MEDIUM- AND HIGH-TEMPERATURE WATER HEATING

System Characteristics 15.1
Basic System 15.2
Design Considerations 15.2
Distribution Piping Design 15.6
Heat Exchangers 15.6
Air-Heating Coils 15.6
Space-Heating Equipment 15.6
Instrumentation and Controls 15.7
Water Treatment 15.7
Heat Storage 15.8
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MEDIUM-TEMPERATURE water (MTW) systems have operating temperatures ranging from 120 to 175°C and are designed to a pressure rating of 860 to 1030 kPa (gage). High-temperature water (HTW) systems are classified as those operating with supply water temperatures above 175°C and designed to a pressure rating of 2000 kPa (gage). The usual practical temperature limit is about 230°C because of pressure limitations on standard carbon steel pipe fittings, equipment, and accessories. Greater temperatures and pressures require more unusual and expensive materials than low-temperature water (LTW) systems, which are under 121°C such as chrome-moly piping. The rapid pressure rise that occurs as the temperature rises above 230°C increases cost because components rated for higher pressures are required (see Figure 1). The design principles for both medium- and high-temperature systems are basically the same.

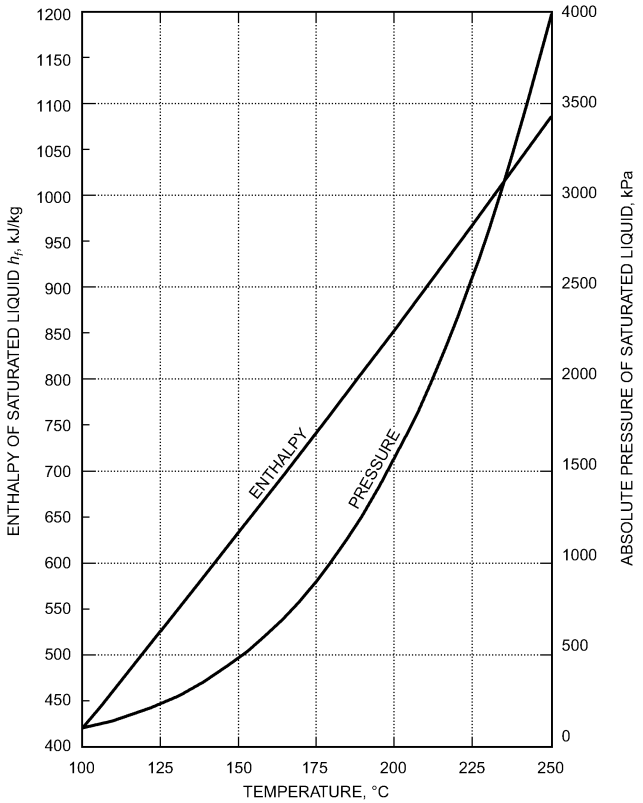

Fig. 1 Relation of Saturation Pressure and Enthalpy to Water Temperature

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.2, District Energy.

This chapter presents the general principles and practices that apply to MTW/HTW systems and distinguishes them from low-temperature water systems operating below 120°C. See Chapter 13 for basic design considerations applicable to all hot-water systems, and Chapter 12 for guidance on larger district hot-water systems.

1. SYSTEM CHARACTERISTICS

The following characteristics distinguish HTW systems from steam distribution or low-temperature water systems:

- The system is a completely closed circuit with supply and return mains maintained under pressure. There are no heat losses from flashing from steam condensate, and heat that is not used in the terminal heat transfer equipment is returned to the MTW or HTW generator. Tight piping systems have minimal corrosion.
- Mechanical equipment that does not control performance of individual terminal units is concentrated at the central plant.
- Piping can slope up or down or run at a variety of elevations to suit the terrain and the architectural and structural requirements without provision for trapping at each low point. For buried systems, this may reduce the amount of excavation required and eliminate drip points, access ports, and return pumps required with steam. Manual air vents must be provided at all high points in the system.
- Greater temperature drops are used and less water is circulated than in low-temperature water systems.
- The pressure in any part of the system must always be above the pressure corresponding to the temperature at saturation in the system to prevent the water flashing into steam. Pressure at the expansion/compression tank is customarily 200 kPa (gage) above the saturation pressure.
- Terminal units requiring different water temperatures can be served at their required temperatures by regulating the flow of water, modulating water supply temperature, placing some units in series, and using heat exchangers or other methods.
- The high heat content of the water in the HTW circuit acts as a thermal flywheel, evening out fluctuations in the load. The heat storage capacity can be further increased by adding heat storage tanks or by increasing the temperature in the return mains during periods of light load.
- The high heat content of the heat carrier makes MTW/HTW systems unsuitable for two-pipe dual-temperature (i.e., two-pipe changeover systems that seasonally switch between hot and chilled water in the same pipe) applications and for intermittent operation if rapid start-up and shutdown are desired, unless the system is designed for minimum water volume and is operated with rapid response controls.
- Basic engineering skills are required to design a HTW system that is simple, yet safer and more convenient to operate than a comparable steam system.
- HTW system design requires greater attention to basic laws of chemistry, thermodynamics, and physics because these systems are less forgiving than standard LTW hydronic systems.

2. BASIC SYSTEM

MTW/HTW systems are similar to conventional forced hot-water heating systems in many ways. They require a heat source (which can be a direct-fired HTW generator, a steam boiler, or an open or closed heat exchanger) to heat the water. The expansion of the heated water is usually compensated for by using an expansion vessel, which also pressurizes the system. Heat transport depends on circulating pumps. The distribution system is closed, comprising supply and return pipes under the same basic pressure. Heat emission at the terminal unit is indirect by heat transfer through heat transfer surfaces in devices such as converters (heat exchangers) or steam generators. The basic system is shown in Figure 2.

The main differences between MTW/HTW and LTW systems are the higher pressures required, greater use of industrial equipment, generally smaller pipe sizes, and manner in which water pressure is maintained. (MTW/HTW systems use inert gas or a pump-pressurized system, in which the pressure is imposed externally.)

HTW generators and all auxiliaries (such as water makeup and feed equipment, pressure tanks, and circulating pumps) are usually located in a central station. Cascade MTW/HTW converters use an existing steam distribution system and are installed remote from the central plant.

3. DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

Selection of the system pressure, supply temperature, temperature drop, type of HTW generator, and pressurization method are the most important initial design considerations. The following are some of the determining factors:

- Type of load (space heating and/or process); load fluctuations during a 24 h period and a 1 year period. Process loads might require water at a given minimum supply temperature continuously, whereas space heating can allow temperature modulation as a function of outdoor temperature or other climatic influences.
- Terminal unit temperature requirements or steam pressures required in process systems.
- Distance between heating plant and space or process requiring heat.
- Quantity and pressure of steam used for power equipment in the central plant.
- Elevation variations within the system and the effect of basic pressure distribution.

Usually, distribution piping is the major investment in an HTW system. A distribution system with the widest differential temperature spread Δt between supply and return will have the lowest initial and operating costs. Economical designs have a Δt of 85 K or higher.

The requirements of terminal equipment or user systems determine the system selected. For example, if the users are 70 kPa (gage) steam generators, the return temperatures would be 120°C. A 2000 kPa (gage) rated system operated at 200°C would be selected to serve the load. In another example, where the primary system serves predominantly 60 to 80°C hot-water heating systems, a MTW system that operates at 160°C could be selected. The supply temperature is reduced by blending with 60°C return water to the desired 82°C supply temperature in a direct-connected hot-water secondary system. This highly economical design has a 60°C return temperature in the primary water system and a Δt of 100 K. However, water-to-water converters are often used to limit pressures in occupied spaces, and the MTW return temperature will be 80°C or the Δt 85 K.

Because the danger of water hammer is always present when the pressure drops to the point at which pressurized hot water flashes to steam, the primary HTW system should be designed with steel

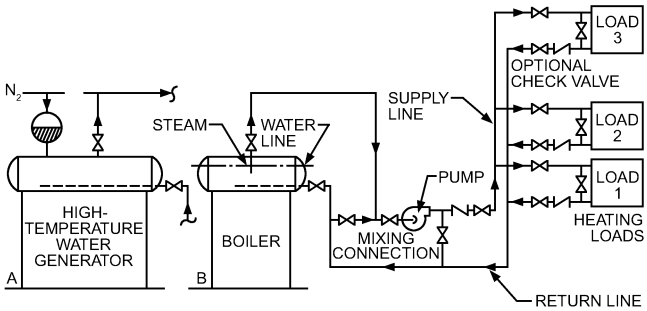

Fig. 2 Elements of High-Temperature Water System

valves and fittings of at least 1 MPa. The secondary water, which operates below 100°C and is not subject to flashing and water hammer, can be designed for 860 kPa and standard HVAC equipment.

Theoretically, water temperatures up to about 175°C can be provided using equipment suitable for 860 kPa. In practice, however, maximum water temperatures are limited by the system design, pump pressures, and elevation characteristics to values between 150 and 160°C.

Most MTW/HTW systems are designed for inert-gas pressurization. The pressurizing tank is connected to the system by a single balance line on the suction side of the circulating pump. This establishes the point in the system at which the pressure does not change during operation and is significant in controlling system pressures and ingestion of air into the system. The circulating pump is located at the inlet side of the HTW generator. There is no flow through the pressurizing tank, and a reduced temperature will normally establish itself inside. A special characteristic of a gas-pressurized system is the apparatus that creates and maintains gas pressure inside the tank.

In designing and operating an MTW/HTW system, it is important to maintain a pressure that always exceeds the vapor pressure of the water, even if the system is not operating. This may require limiting the water temperature and thereby the vapor pressure, or increasing the imposed pressure.

Elevation and the pressures required to prevent water from flashing into steam in the supply system can also limit the maximum water temperature that may be used and must therefore be studied in evaluating the temperature-pressure relationships and method of pressurizing the system.

The properties of water that govern design are as follows:

- Temperature versus pressure at saturation (Figure 1)
- Density or specific volume versus temperature
- Enthalpy or sensible heat versus temperature
- Viscosity versus temperature
- Type and amount of pressurization

The relationships among temperature, pressure, specific volume, and enthalpy are all available in steam tables. Some properties of water are summarized in Table 1 and Figure 3.

Direct-Fired High-Temperature Water Generators

In direct-fired HTW generators, the central stations are comparable to steam boiler plants operating within the same pressure range. The generators should be selected for size and type in keeping with the load and design pressures, as well as the circulation requirements peculiar to high-temperature water. In some systems, both steam for power or processing and high-temperature water are supplied from the same boiler; in others, steam is produced in the boilers and used for generating high-temperature water; in contemporary systems, the burning fuel directly heats the water.

Table 1 Properties of Water, 100 to 210°C

Temperature, °C	Absolute Pressure, kPa*	Density, kg/m³	Specific Heat, kJ/(kg·K)	Total Heat above 0°C		Dynamic Viscosity, mPa·s
				kJ/kg*	MJ/m³	
100	101.3	958.1	4.22	419.1	401.5	0.284
110	143.3	950.7	4.23	461.3	438.6	0.257
120	198.5	942.8	4.25	503.7	474.9	0.234
130	270.1	934.6	4.27	546.3	510.6	0.215
140	361.4	925.9	4.29	589.2	545.5	0.198
150	476.0	916.9	4.32	632.2	579.7	0.184
160	618.1	907.0	4.35	675.5	612.7	0.171
170	792.0	897.4	4.38	719.2	645.4	0.160
180	1002.7	887.0	4.42	763.2	676.9	0.150
190	1255.1	875.8	4.46	807.6	707.3	0.142
200	1554.9	864.5	4.51	852.5	736.9	0.134
210	1907.7	853.0	4.56	897.8	765.8	0.127

*Source: *Thermodynamic Properties of Steam*, J.H. Keenan and F.G. Keyes, John Wiley & Sons, 1936 edition.

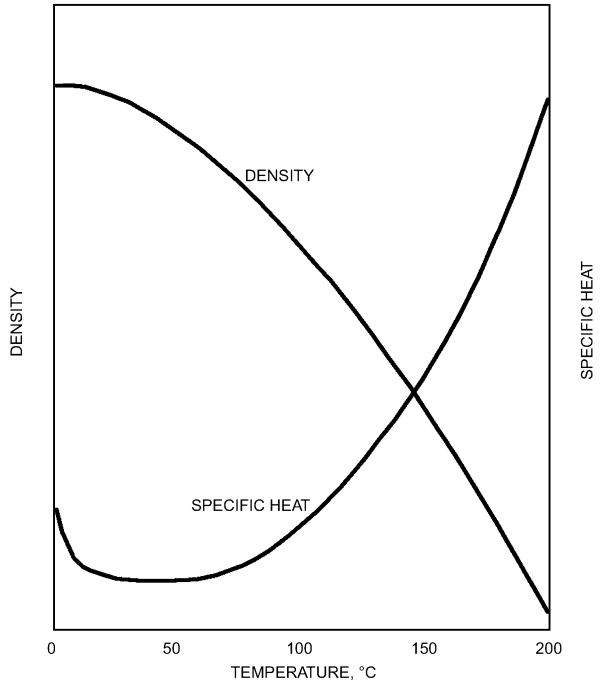

Fig. 3 Density and Specific Heat of Water

HTW generators are predominantly water-tube, and can be equipped with any conventional fuel-firing apparatus. Water-tube generators can have either forced circulation, gravity circulation, or a combination of both. The recirculating pumps of forced-circulation generators must operate continuously while the generator is being fired. Forced-circulation HTW generators are usually the once-through type and rely solely on pumps to achieve circulation. Depending on the design, internal orifices in the various circuits may be required to regulate the water flow rates in proportion to the heat absorption rates. Circulation must be maintained at all times while the generator is being fired, and the flow rate must never drop below the minimum indicated by the manufacturer. Fire-tube boilers designed for MTW/HTW service may be used, but thermal shock, which damages tubes and tube sheets, caused by sudden drops in the return temperature (sudden load increases), is difficult to avoid. Therefore, fire-tube generators should be avoided, used in small systems, or at least used with caution.

A separate vessel is always used when the system is cushioned by an inert gas. Proper internal circulation is essential in all types of generators to prevent tube failures caused by overheating or unequal expansion.

Expansion and Pressurization

In addition to the information in Chapter 13, the following factors should be considered:

- The connection point of the expansion tank used for pressurization greatly affects the pressure distribution throughout the system and the avoidance of HTW flashing. For stable pressure control, the expansion tank balance line should be attached to the inlet side of the MTW/HTW generator. It is the only point of no pressure change in the system.
- Proper safety devices for high and low water levels and excessive pressures should be incorporated in the expansion tank and interlocked with combustion safety and water flow rate controls.

The following four fundamental methods, in which pressure in a given hydraulic system can be kept at a desired level, amplify the discussion in Chapter 13 (Blossom and Ziel 1959; National Academy of Sciences 1959).

Elevating the Storage Tank. This is a simple pressurization method, but because of the great heights required for the pressure encountered, it is generally impractical.

Steam Pressurization. This method requires the use of an expansion vessel separate from the HTW generator. Steam pressurization systems are seldom used in contemporary systems; detailed discussion of this method of pressurization may be found in previous editions of this chapter or noted in references therein.

The expansion vessel must be equipped with steam safety valves capable of relieving the steam generated by all the generators. The generators themselves are usually designed for a substantially higher working pressure than the expansion drum, and their safety relief valves are set for the higher pressure to minimize their lift requirement.

The basic HTW pumping arrangements can be either single-pump, in which one pump handles both the generator and system loads, or two-pump, in which one pump circulates high-temperature water through the generator and a second pump circulates high-temperature water through the system. The circulating pump moves

the water from the expansion vessel to the system and back to the generator. The vessel must be elevated to increase the net positive suction pressure to prevent cavitation or flashing in the pump suction. This arrangement is critical. A bypass from the HTW system return line to the pump suction helps prevent flashing. Cooler return water is then mixed with hotter water from the expansion vessel to give a resulting temperature below the corresponding saturation point in the vessel.

Inert-Gas Pressurization. Nitrogen is the most commonly used inert gas for pressurization. Air is not recommended, because the oxygen in air contributes to corrosion in the system.

The expansion vessel is connected as close as possible to the suction side of the HTW pump by a balance line. The inert gas used for pressurization is fed into the top of the cylinder, preferably through a manual fill connection using a reducing station connected to an inert gas cylinder. Locating the relief valve below the minimum water line is advantageous, because it is easier to keep it tightly sealed with water on the pressure side. If the valve is located above the water line, it is exposed to the inert gas of the system.

To reduce the area of contact between gas and water and the resulting absorption of gas into the water, the tank should be installed vertically. It should be located in the most suitable place in the central plant. Similar to the steam-pressurized system, the pumping arrangements can be either one- or two-pump (see Figures 4 and 5).

The ratings of fittings, valves, piping, and equipment are considered in determining the maximum system pressure. A minimum pressure of about 170 to 340 kPa over the maximum saturation pressure can be used. The imposed additional pressure above the vapor pressure must be large enough to prevent steaming in the HTW generators at all times, even under conditions when flow and firing rates in generators operated in parallel, or flow and heat absorption in parallel circuits within a generator, are not evenly matched. This is critical, because gas-pressurized systems do not have steam separating means and safety valves to evacuate the steam generated.

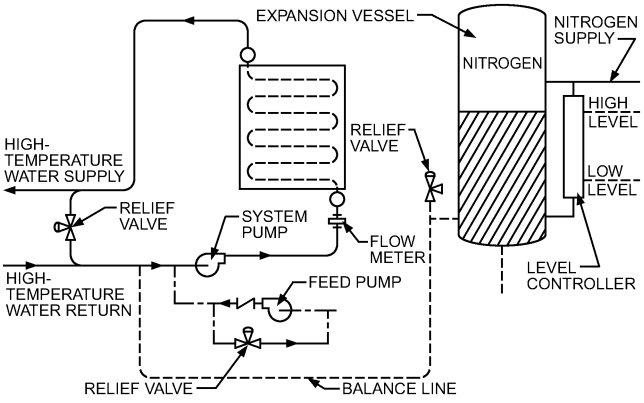

Fig. 4 Inert-Gas Pressurization for Primary-Pumped System

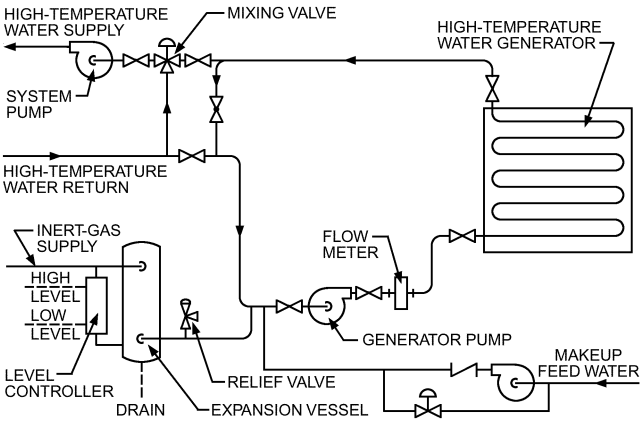

Fig. 5 Inert-Gas Pressurization for Primary/Secondary-Pumped System

The simplest type of gas-pressurization system uses a variable gas quantity with or without gas recovery (Figure 6) (National Academy of Sciences 1959). When the water rises, the inert gas is relieved from the expansion vessel and is wasted or recovered in a low-pressure gas receiver from which the gas compressor pumps it into a high-pressure receiver for storage. When the water level drops in the expansion vessel, the control cycle adds inert gas from bottles or from the high-pressure receiver to the expansion vessel to maintain the required pressure.

Gas wastage can significantly affect the operating cost. The gas recovery system should be analyzed based on the economics of each application. Gas recovery is generally more applicable to larger systems.

Sizing. The vessel should be sized for a total volume V_T, which is the sum of the volume V_1 required for pressurization, the volume V_2 required for water expansion, and the volume V_3 required for sludge and reserve.

Calculations made on the basis of pressure-volume variations following Boyle's Law are reasonably accurate, assuming that the tank operates at a relatively constant temperature. The minimum gas volume can be determined from the expansion volume V_2 and from the control range between the minimum tank pressure P_1 and the maximum tank pressure P_2. The gas volume varies from the minimum V_1 to a maximum, which includes the water expansion volume V_2.

The minimum gas volume V_1 can be obtained from

$$V_1 = P_1 V_2/(P_2 - P_1)$$

where P_1 and P_2 are units of absolute pressure.

An allowance of 10% of the sum of V_1 and V_2 is a reasonable estimate of the sludge and reserve capacity V_3. The volume V_2 required for water expansion should be limited to the actual

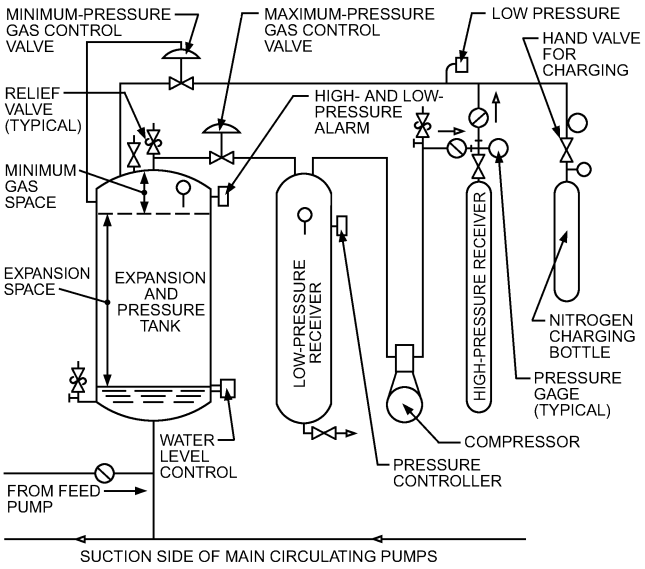

Fig. 6 Inert-Gas Pressurization Using Variable Gas Quantity with Gas Recovery

expansion that occurs during operation through its minimum to maximum operating temperatures. It is necessary to bleed off water during a start-up cycle from a cold start. It is practicable on small systems (e.g., under 0.3 to 3 MW) to size the expansion vessel for the total water expansion from the initial fill temperature.

Pump Pressurization. In its simplest form, this method requires a feed pump and a regulator valve. The pump operates continuously, introducing water from the makeup tank into the system. The pressure regulator valve bleeds continuously back into the makeup tank. This method is usually restricted to small process heating systems. However, it can be used to temporarily pressurize a larger system to avoid shutdown during inspection of the expansion tank.

In larger central HTW systems, pump pressurization is combined with a fixed-quantity gas compression tank that acts as a buffer. When the pressure rises above a preset value in the buffer tank, a control valve opens to relieve water from the balance line into the makeup storage tank. When the pressure falls below a preset second value, the feed pump is started automatically to pump water from the makeup tank back into the system. The buffer tank is designed to absorb only the limited expansion volume that is required for the pressure control system to function properly; it is usually small.

To prevent corrosion-causing elements, principally oxygen, from entering the HTW system, the makeup storage tank is usually closed and a low-pressure nitrogen cushion of 7 to 35 kPa (gage) is maintained. The gas cushion is usually the variable gas quantity type with release to the atmosphere.

Direct-Contact Heaters (Cascades)

High-temperature water can be obtained from direct-contact heaters in which steam from turbine exhaust, extraction, or steam boilers is mixed with return water from the system. The mixing takes place in the upper part of the heater where the water cascading from horizontal baffles comes in direct contact with steam (Hansen 1966). The basic systems are shown in Figures 7 and 8.

The steam space in the upper part of the heater serves as the steam cushion for pressurizing the system. The lower part of the heater serves as the system's expansion tank. Where the water heater and the boiler operate under the same pressure, the surplus water is usually returned directly into the boiler through a pipe connecting the outlet of the high-temperature water-circulating pump to the boiler.

The cascade system is also applicable where both steam and HTW services are required (Hansen and Liddy 1958). Where heat and power production are combined, the direct-contact heater becomes the mixing condenser (Hansen and Perrsall 1960).

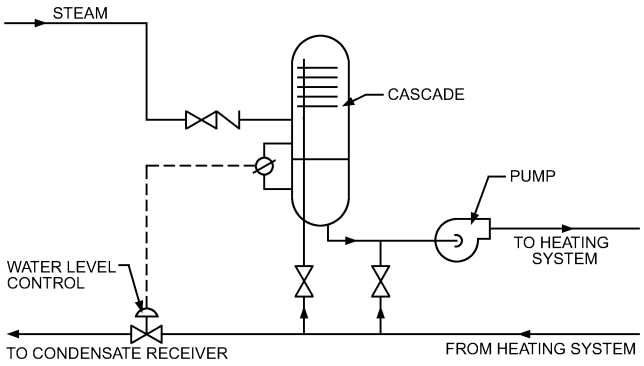

Fig. 7 Cascade HTW System

System Circulating Pumps

Forced-circulation MTW/HTW generator systems can be either primary or primary/secondary. These terms refer to the circulation loops that they serve. In the primary system, a single pump or set of pumps (see Figure 4) circulates water to both generator and distribution system. In this system, both the distribution system and the generator loops are served (Blossom and Ziel 1959).

However, to ensure at least minimum flow through the generator at all times, a bypass (indicated as a relief valve) around the distribution system must be provided. The primary (single-loop) method usually applies only to systems in which the total friction pressure is relatively low, because the energy loss of available circulating pressure from throttling in the bypass at times of reduced flow requirements in the district can substantially increase the operating cost.

In the primary/secondary (two-loop) system (see Figure 5), an additional group of pumps is installed solely to provide circulation for the generators (Blossom and Ziel 1959). One pump is often used for each generator to draw water from the system return and to pump it through the generator into the system. The system circulating pumps draw water from the generator outlet header and circulate it through the distribution system only. The supply temperature to the distribution system can be varied by mixing water from the return into the supply on the pump suction side. Where zoning is required, several groups of pumps can be used with a different pressure and temperature in each zone. The flow rate can also be varied without affecting the generator circulation and without using a system bypass.

It is common practice to install a mixing connection from the return to the pump suction that bypasses the HTW generator. This connection is used for start-up and for modulating the supply temperature; it should not be relied on for increasing the pressure at the pump inlet. Where it is impossible to provide the required submergence by proper design, a separate small-bore premixing line should be provided.

Hansen (1966) describes push-pull (i.e., booster) pumping, which divides the circulating pressure equally between two pump sets in series. One is placed in the supply and is sized to overcome frictional resistance in the supply line of the heat distribution system. The second pump is placed in the return and is sized to overcome frictional resistance in the return. The expansion tank pressure is impressed on the system between the pumps. The HTW generator is either between the pumps or in the supply line from the pumps to

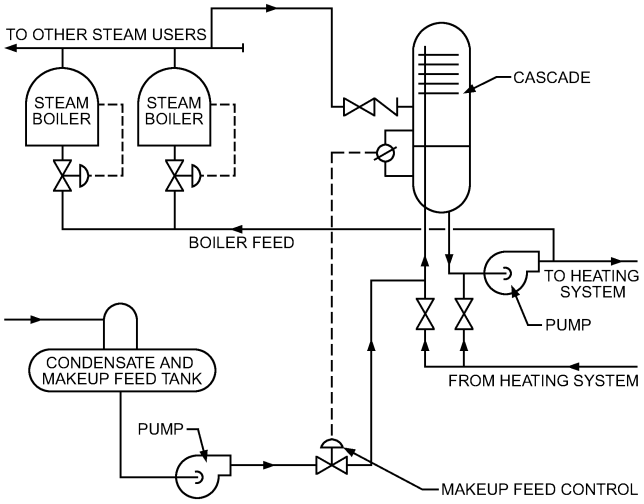

Fig. 8 Cascade HTW System Combined with Boiler Feedwater Preheating

the distribution system. More detailed information about push-pull pumping system design is provided in previous editions of this chapter.

Pumps for MTW/HTW service must be provided with air or water cooling systems to provide cooling for mechanical seals. This is most important in HTW systems. System water is run through high-efficiency filters and cooled by compact air- or potable-water-cooled heat exchangers to cool and flush the seal surfaces. Such pumps are also found in chemical processing systems.

4. DISTRIBUTION PIPING DESIGN

Data for pipe friction are presented in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. These pipe friction and fitting loss tables are for a 15 °C water temperature. When applied to HTW systems, the values obtained are excessively high. The data should be used for preliminary pipe sizing only. Final pressure drop calculations should be made using the fundamental Darcy-Weisbach equation (Equation 1 in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*) in conjunction with friction factors, pipe roughness, and fitting loss coefficients presented in the section on Flow Analysis in Chapter 3 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

The conventional buried conduit or tunnel distribution systems are used with similar techniques for installation (see Chapter 12). A small valved bypass connection between the supply and the return pipe should be installed at the end of long runs to maintain a slight circulation in the mains during periods of minimum or no demand, not only to keep the loop warm, but also to maintain circulation of water treatment through the system to prevent internal corrosion. For sophisticated systems, a motorized valve on a timer can be used.

All pipe, valves, and fittings used in HTW systems should comply with the requirements of ASME *Standard* B-31.1 and the *National Fuel Gas Code* (NFPA 54/ANSI Z223.1). These codes state that hot-water systems should be designed for the highest pressure and temperature actually existing in the piping under normal operation. This pressure equals cushion pressure plus pump pressure plus static pressure. Schedule 40 steel pipe is applicable to most HTW systems with welded steel fittings and steel valves. The number of joints should be minimized. In many installations, all valves in the piping system are welded or brazed. Flange connections used at major equipment can be serrated, raised flange facing, or ring joint. It is desirable to have back-seating valves with special packing suitable for this service.

Valve quality, especially at headers, end-use equipment, and similar points requiring positive shutoff over time for maintenance, is very important. Valve selection must consider both initial and long-term capability to provide tight shutoff. New technologies, such as triple-offset butterfly valves, provide these characteristics and should be considered for use in MTW/HTW systems at critical points. Life-cycle costs favor valves that ensure tight shutoff no matter how long they are in service.

The ratings of valves, pipe, and fittings must be checked to determine the specific rating point for the given application. The pressure rating for a standard 2000 kPa steel valve operating at 204 °C is 4600 kPa. Therefore, it is generally not necessary in MTW/HTW systems to use steel valves and fittings with ratings greater than 2000 kPa.

Because high-temperature water is more penetrating than low-temperature water, leakage caused partly by capillary action should not be ignored, because even a small amount of leakage vaporizes immediately. This slight leakage becomes noticeable only on the outside of the gland and stem of the valve where thin deposits of salt are left after evaporation. Avoid screwed joints and fittings in HTW systems. Pipe unions should not be used in place of flange connections, even for small-bore piping and equipment.

Individual heating equipment units should be installed with separate valves for shutoff. These should be readily accessible. If the unit is to be isolated for service, valves are needed in both the supply and return piping to the unit. Valve trim should be stainless steel or a similar alloy. Do not use brass and bronze.

High points in piping should have air vents for collecting and removing air, and low points should have provision for drainage. Loop-type expansion joints, in which the expansion is absorbed by deflection of the pipe loop, are preferable to the mechanical type. Mechanical expansion joints must be properly guided and anchored.

5. HEAT EXCHANGERS

Heat exchangers or converters commonly use steel shells with stainless steel, admiralty metal, or cupronickel tubes. Copper should not be used in HTW systems above 120 °C. Material must be chosen carefully, considering the pressure-temperature characteristics of the particular system. All connections should be flanged or welded. On larger exchangers, water box-type construction is desirable to remove the tube bundle without breaking piping connections. Normally, HTW is circulated through the tubes, and because the heated water contains dissolved air, the baffles in the shell should be constructed of the same material as the tubes to control corrosion.

6. AIR-HEATING COILS

In HTW systems over 200 °C, coils should be cupronickel or all-steel construction. Below this point, other materials (e.g., red brass) can be used after determining their suitability for the temperatures involved. Coils in outdoor air connections need freeze protection by damper closure or fan shutdown controlled by a thermostat. It is also possible to set the control valve on the preheat coil to a minimum position. This protects against freezing, as long as there is no unbalance in the tube circuits where parallel paths of HTW flow exist. A better method is to provide constant flow through the coil and to control heat output with face and bypass dampers or by modulating the water temperature with a mixing pump.

7. SPACE-HEATING EQUIPMENT

In industrial areas, space-heating equipment can be operated with the available high-temperature water. Convectors and radiators may require water temperatures in the low- and medium-temperature range 50 to 80°C or 90 to 120°C, depending on their design pressure and proximity to the occupants. The water velocity through the heating equipment affects its capacity. This must be considered in selecting the equipment because, if a large water temperature drop is used, the circulation rate is reduced and, consequently, the flow velocity may be reduced enough to appreciably lower the heat transfer rate.

Convectors, specially designed to provide low surface temperatures, are now available to operate with water temperatures from 150 to 200 °C.

These high temperatures are suitable for direct use in radiant panel surfaces. However, if the radiant panels might be touched by occupants, lower temperatures should be used, not MTW/HTM directly. Because radiant output is a fourth-power function of the surface temperature, the surface area requirements are reduced over low-temperature water systems. The surfaces can be flat panels consisting of a steel tube, usually 10 to 13 mm, welded to sheet steel turned up at the edges for stiffening. Several variations are available. Steel pipe can also be used with an aluminum or similar reflector to reflect the heat downward and to prevent smudging the surfaces above the pipe.

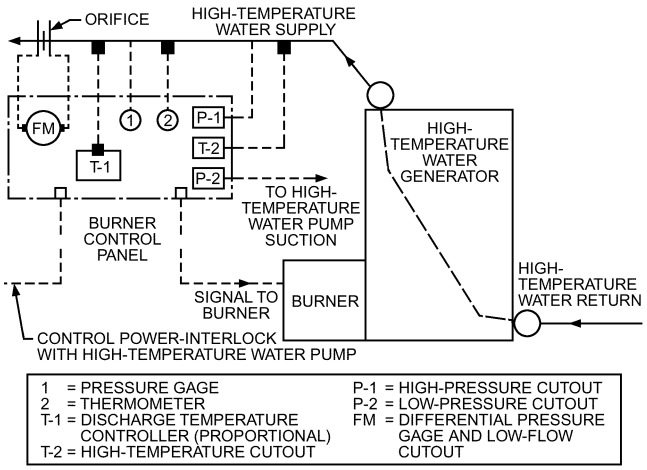

Fig. 9 Control Diagram for HTW Generator

8. INSTRUMENTATION AND CONTROLS

Pressure gages should be installed in the pump discharge and suction and at locations where pressure readings will assist operation and maintenance. Thermometers (preferably dial-type) or thermometer wells should be installed in the flow and return pipes, the pump discharge, and at any other points of major temperature change or where temperatures are important in operating the system. It is desirable to have thermometers and gages in the piping at the entrance to each building converter.

Inert-gas-pressurized systems should be controlled from the generator discharge temperature. Combustion controls are discussed in detail in Chapter 31.

In the water-tube generators most commonly used for HTW applications, the flow of water passes through the generator in seconds. The temperature controller must have a rapid response to maintain a reasonably uniform leaving water temperature.

Keep the controls simple. The rapid response through the generator makes it necessary to modulate the combustion rate on all systems with a capacity of over 0.5 megawatt. In the smaller size range, this can be done by high/low firing. In large systems, particularly those used for central heating applications, full modulation of the combustion rate is desirable through at least 20% of full capacity. On/off burner control is generally not used in steam-pressurized cycles because the system loses pressurization during the off cycle, which can cause flashing and cavitation at the HTW pumps.

All generators should have separate safety controls to shut down the combustion apparatus when the system pressure or water temperature is high. HTW generators require a minimum water flow at all times to prevent tube failure. Means should be provided to measure the flow and to stop combustion if the flow falls below the minimum value recommended by the generator manufacturer. For inert-gas-pressurized cycles, a low-pressure safety control should be included to shut down the combustion system if pressurization is lost. Figure 9 shows the basic schematic control diagram for an HTW generator.

Control valve selection and sizing are important because of relatively high temperature drops and smaller flows in HTW systems. The valve must be sized so that it is effective over its full range of travel. The valve and equipment must be sized to absorb, in the control valve at full flow, not less than half the available pressure difference between supply and return mains where the equipment is served. An equal-percentage valve is typically used. Sometimes, two small valves or a one-third/two-third provide better control

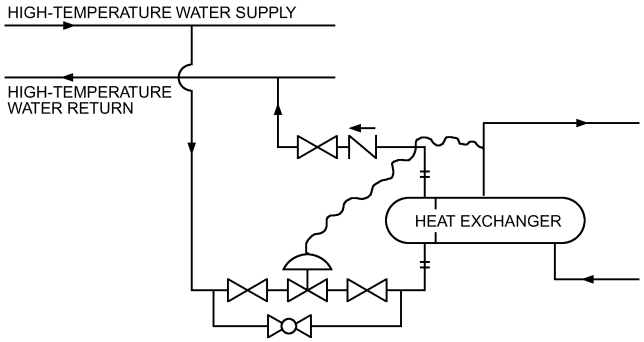

Fig. 10 Heat Exchanger Connections

than one large valve, due to the turndown capabilities over the range of flow. Stainless steel trim is recommended, and all valve body materials and packing should be suitable for high temperatures and pressures. The valve should have a close-off rating at least equal to the maximum pressure produced by the circulating pump. Generally, two-way valves are more desirable than three-way valves because of equal percentage flow characteristics and the smaller capacities available in two-way valves. Single-seated valves are preferable to double-seated valves because the latter do not offer tight shutoff capability.

Control valves are commonly located in the return lines from heat transfer units to reduce the valve operating temperature and to prevent plug erosion caused by high-temperature water flashing to steam at lower discharge pressure. A typical application is for controlling the temperature of water being heated in a heat exchanger where the heating medium is high-temperature water. The temperature-measuring element of the controller is installed on the secondary side and should be located where it can best detect changes to prevent overheating of outlet water. When the measuring element is located in the outlet pipe, there must be a continuous flow through the exchanger and past the element. The controller regulates the HTW supply to the primary side by means of the control valve in the HTW return. If the water leaving the exchanger is used for space heating, the set point of the thermostat in this water can be readjusted according to outdoor temperature.

Another typical application is to control a low- or medium-pressure steam generator, usually less than 350 kPa (gage), using high-temperature water as the heat source. In this application, a proportional pressure controller measures the steam pressure on the secondary side and positions the HTW control valve on the primary side to maintain the desired steam pressure. For general information on automatic controls, refer to Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Where submergence is sufficient to prevent flashing in the **vena contracta**, control valves can be in the HTW supply instead of in the return to water heaters and steam generators (Figure 10). When used in conjunction with a check valve in the return, this arrangement shuts off the high-temperature water supply to the heat exchangers if a tube bundle leaks or ruptures.

9. WATER TREATMENT

Water treatment for HTW systems should be referred to a specialist. However, the design engineer should be conversant with the technology to ensure that systems are not overtreated. MTW/HTW systems designed to minimize water loss in the system require minimal chemical additions. Experience shows that, in a well-designed, tight system, the pressure drop in the piping decreases over time as mill scale is removed from the interior of the pipe. Pretreatment of

makeup water, based on local water characteristics, is important. Such pretreatment systems are relatively small because of the limited amount of water loss that occurs at valve packings. The presence of stalagmites of chemical crystals is a good indicator that a system is being overtreated. Oxygen introduced in makeup water immediately oxidizes steel at these temperatures, and over a period of time the corrosion can be substantial if air ingestion is not a primary design consideration. Other impurities can also harm generator tubes. Solids in impure water left by invisible vapor escaping at packings increase maintenance requirements. The condition of the water and the steel surfaces should be checked periodically in systems operating at these temperatures.

For further information, see Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications,* especially the section on Water-Heating Systems under Selection of Water Treatment.

10. HEAT STORAGE

The high heat storage capacity of water produces a flywheel effect in most HTW systems that evens out load fluctuations. Systems with normal peaks can obtain as much as 15% added capacity through such heat (thermal energy) storage. Excessive peak and low loads of a cyclic nature can be mitigated by using an HTW accumulator, based on the principle of stratification. Heat storage in an extensive system can sometimes be increased by bypassing water from the supply into the return at the end of the mains, or by raising the temperature of the returns during periods of low load. Adding an accumulator to the system must be researched carefully, because, unlike when storing chilled water, a hot-water tank using MTW/HTW requires that the tank be a pressure vessel and not atmospheric.

11. SAFETY CONSIDERATIONS

A properly engineered and operated HTW system is safe and dependable. Careful selection and arrangement of components and materials are important. Piping must be designed and installed to prevent undue stress. When high-temperature water is released to atmospheric pressure, flashing takes place, which absorbs a large portion of the energy. Turbulent mixing of the liquid and vapor with room air reduces the temperature well below 100°C. With low mass flow rates, the temperature of the escaping mixture can fall to 52 to 60°C within a short distance, compared with the temperature of the discharge of a low-temperature water system, which remains essentially the same as the temperature of the working fluid (Armstrong and Harris 1966; Hansen 1959).

If large mass flow rates of HTW are released to atmospheric pressure in a confined space (e.g., rupture of a large pipe or vessel) a hazardous condition could exist, similar to that occurring with the rupture of a large steam main. Failures of this nature are rare if good engineering practice is followed in system design.

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CHAPTER 16

INFRARED RADIANT HEATING

Energy Conservation 16.1
Infrared Energy Sources 16.1
System Efficiency 16.4
Reflectors 16.4
Controls 16.4
Precautions 16.4
Maintenance 16.5
Design Considerations for Beam Radiant Heaters 16.5

INFRARED radiant heating principles discussed in this chapter apply to equipment with thermal radiation source temperatures ranging from 150 to 2760°C. (Equipment with source temperatures starting from below the indoor air temperature to 150°C is classified as panel heating and cooling equipment, discussed in Chapter 6.) Infrared radiant heaters with source temperatures in this range are categorized into three groups as follows:

- **Low-intensity** source temperatures range from 150 to 650°C. A typical low-intensity heater is mounted on the ceiling and may be constructed of a 100 mm steel tube 3 to 24 m long. A gas burner inserted into the end of the tube raises the tube surface temperature, and because most units are equipped with a reflector, thermal radiation is directed down to the heated space.
- **Medium-intensity** source temperatures range from 650 to 980°C. Typical equipment types include porous matrix gas-fired infrared heaters or metal-sheathed electric heaters.
- **High-intensity** source temperatures range from 980 to 2760°C. A typical high-intensity heater is an electrical reflector lamp with a resistor temperature of 2230°C.

Low-, medium-, and high-intensity infrared heaters are frequently applied in aircraft hangars, factories, warehouses, foundries, greenhouses, and gymnasiums. They are applied to open areas such as loading docks, racetrack stands, under marquees, vestibules, outdoor restaurants, carwashes, and around swimming pools. Infrared heaters are also used for snow and ice melting (see Chapter 52 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*), condensation control, and industrial process heating. Reflectors are frequently used to control the distribution of heat flux from thermal radiation in specific patterns.

When infrared radiant heating is used, the environment is characterized by

- A directional thermal radiation field created by the infrared heaters
- A thermal radiation field consisting of reradiation and reflection from the walls and/or other enclosing surfaces
- Ambient air temperatures often lower than those found with convective systems

The combined action of these factors determines occupant thermal comfort and the thermal acceptability of the environment.

1. ENERGY CONSERVATION

Infrared heaters are effective for spot heating. However, because of their efficient performance, they are also used for total heating of large areas and entire buildings (Buckley 1989). Radiant heaters transfer heat directly to solid objects. Little heat is lost during transmission because air is a poor absorber of radiant heat. Because an intermediate transfer medium such as air or water is not required, fans or pumps are not needed.

As thermal radiation warms floors, walls, and objects, they in turn release heat to the air by convection. Reradiation to surrounding objects also contributes to comfort in the area. An energy-saving advantage is that infrared heaters can be turned off when not needed; when turned on again, they are effective in minutes. Even when the infrared heater is off, the heated surrounding objects at occupant level continue to contribute to comfort by reradiating heat and releasing heat by convection.

Human thermal comfort is primarily governed by the operative temperature of the heated space (ASHRAE *Standard* 55). Operative temperature may be approximated by the arithmetic average of the mean radiant temperature (MRT) of the heated space and dry-bulb air temperature, if air velocity is less than 0.4 m/s and MRT is less than 50°C. See Chapter 55 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for further details. In radiant heating, the dry-bulb air temperature may be kept lower for a given comfort level than with other forms of heating because of increased MRT. As a result, heat lost to ventilating air and via conduction through the shell of the structure is proportionally smaller, as is energy consumption. Infiltration loss, which is a function of dry-bulb air temperature, is also reduced.

Because of the unique split of radiant and convective components in radiant heating, air movement and stratification in the heated space is minimal. This further reduces infiltration and transmission heat losses.

Buckley and Seel (1987) compared energy savings of infrared heating with those of other types of heating systems. Recognizing the reduced fuel requirement for these applications, Buckley and Seel (1988) noted that it is desirable for manufacturers of radiant heaters to recommend installation of equipment with a rated output that is 80 to 85% of the heat loss calculated by methods described in Chapters 17 and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. ANSI/ASHRAE *Standard* 138 describes a rated output system for ceiling radiant heaters.

Chapman and Zhang (1995) developed a three-dimensional mathematical model to compute radiant heat exchange between surfaces. A building comfort analysis program (BCAP) was developed as part of ASHRAE research project RP-657 (Jones and Chapman 1994). The BCAP program was later enhanced to analyze the effect of radiant heaters over 150°C on thermal comfort calculations, and to analyze the thermal comfort effect of obstacles in the heated space in ASHRAE research project RP-1037 (Chapman 2002).

2. INFRARED ENERGY SOURCES

Gas Infrared

Modern gas-fired infrared heaters burn gas to heat a specific radiating surface. The surface is heated by direct flame contact or with combustion gases. Studies by the Gas Research Board of London (1944), Haslam et al. (1925), and Plyler (1948) reveal that only 10 to 20% of the energy produced by open combustion of a gaseous fuel is infrared radiant energy. The wavelength span over which radiation from a heated surface is distributed can be controlled by design. The specific radiating surface of a properly designed unit directs radiation toward the load. Gas-fired infrared radiation heaters are available in the following types (see Table 1 for characteristics).

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.5, Radiant Heating and Cooling.

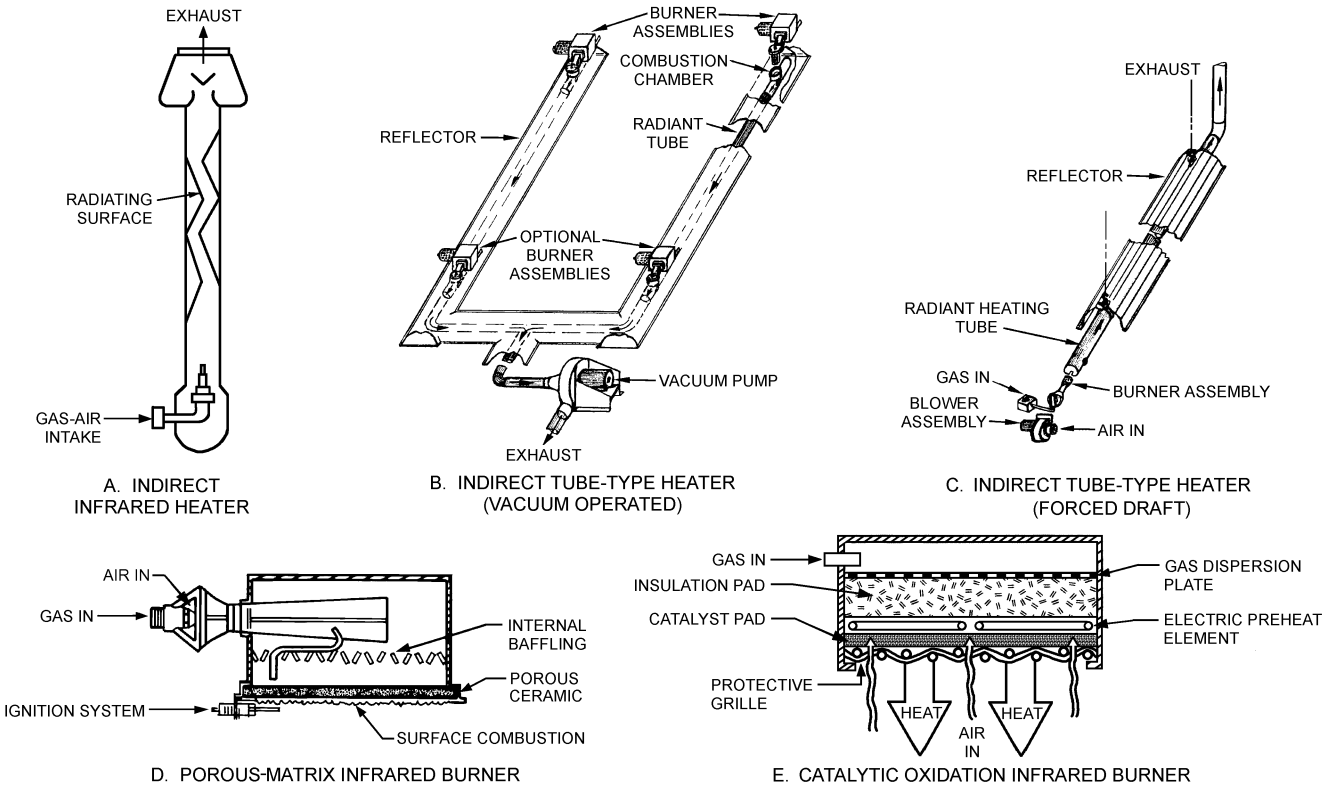

Fig. 1 Types of Gas-Fired Infrared Heaters

Table 1 Characteristics of Typical Gas-Fired Infrared Heaters

Characteristics	Indirect	Porous Matrix	Catalytic Oxidation
Operating source temperature	Up to 650°C	870 to 980°C	340 to 370°C
Relative heat flux,[a] kW/m^2	Low, up to 24	Medium, 54 to 100	Low, 2.5 to 9.5
Response time (heat-up)	180 s	60 s	300 s
Thermal radiation-energy input ratio[b]	0.35 to 0.55	0.35 to 0.60	No data
Thermal shock resistance	Excellent	Excellent	Excellent
Vibration resistance	Excellent	Excellent	Excellent
Color blindness[c]	Excellent	Very good	Excellent
Luminosity (visible light)	To dull red	Yellow red	None
Mounting height	3 to 15 m	4 to 15 m	To 3 m
Wind or draft resistance	Good	Fair	Very good
Venting	Optional	Nonvented	Nonvented
Flexibility	Good	Excellent—wide range of heat fluxes and mounting possibilities available	Limited to low-heat-flux applications

[a]Heat flux emitted at burner surface.
[b]Ratio of thermal radiation to energy output to input.
[c]Color blindness refers to absorptance by various loads of energy emitted by different sources.

Indirect infrared radiation heaters (Figures 1A, 1B, and 1C) are internally fired and have the radiating surface between the hot gases and the load. Combustion takes place within the radiating elements, which operate with surface temperatures up to 650°C. The elements may be tubes or panels with metal or ceramic components. Indirect infrared radiation units are usually vented and may require eductors.

Porous-matrix infrared radiation heaters (Figure 1D) have a refractory material that may be porous ceramic, drilled port ceramic, stainless steel, or a metallic screen. The units are enclosed, except for the major surface facing the load. A combustible gas-air mixture enters the enclosure, flows through the refractory material to the exposed face, and is distributed evenly by the porous character of the refractory. Combustion occurs evenly on the exposed surface. The flame recedes into the matrix, which adds radiant energy to the flame. If the refractory porosity is suitable, an atmospheric burner can be used, resulting in a surface temperature approaching 900°C. Power burner operation may be required if refractory density is high. However, the resulting surface temperature may also be higher (980°C).

Catalytic oxidation infrared radiation heaters (Figure 1E) are similar to porous-matrix units in construction, appearance, and operation, but the refractory material is usually glass wool, and the radiating surface is a catalyst that causes oxidation to proceed without visible flames.

Electric Infrared

Electric infrared heaters use heat produced by electric current flowing in a high-resistance wire, graphite ribbon, or film element. The following are the most commonly used types (see Table 2 for characteristics).

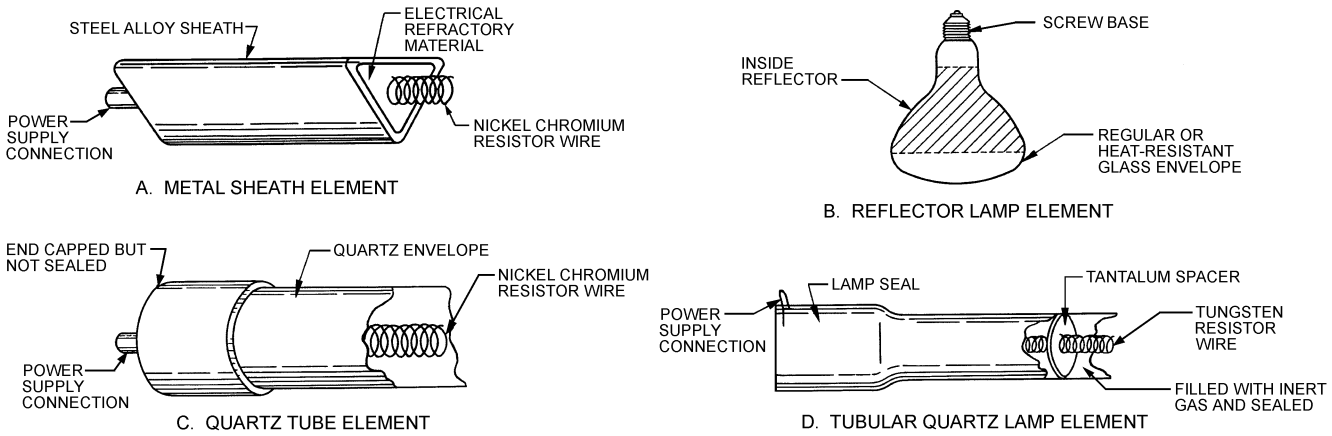

Fig. 2 Common Electric Infrared Heaters

Table 2 Characteristics of Four Electric Infrared Elements

Characteristic	Metal Sheath	Reflector Lamp	Quartz Tube	Quartz Lamp
Resistor material	Nickel-chromium alloy	Tungsten wire	Nickel-chromium alloy	Tungsten wire
Relative linear heat flux	Medium, 2.4 kW/m,13 mm diameter	High, 125 to 375 W/spot	Medium to high, 3.0 kW/m, 13 mm diameter	High, 3.9 kW/m, 9.5 mm diameter
Resistor temperature	950°C	2230°C	930°C	2230°C
Envelope temperature (in use)	840°C	275 to 300°C	650°C	590°C
Thermal radiation-energy input ratio[a]	0.58	0.86	0.81	0.86
Response time (heat-up)	180 s	A few seconds	60 s	A few seconds
Luminosity (visible light)	Very low (dull red)	High (8 lm/W)	Low (orange)	High (7.5 lm/W)
Thermal shock resistance	Excellent	Poor to excellent (heat-resistant glass)	Excellent	Excellent
Vibration resistance	Excellent	Medium	Medium	Medium
Impact resistance	Excellent	Medium	Poor	Poor
Wind or draft resistance[b]	Medium	Excellent	Medium	Excellent
Mounting position	Any	Any	Horizontal[c]	Horizontal
Envelope material	Steel alloy	Regular or heat-resistant glass	Translucent quartz	Clear, translucent, or frost quartz and integral red filter glass
Color blindness	Very good	Fair	Very good	Fair
Flexibility	Good—wide range of power density, length, and voltage practical	Limited to 125-250 and 375 W at 120 V	Excellent—wide range of power density, diameter, length, and voltage practical	Limited—1 to 3 W for each V; 1 length for each capacity
Life expectancy	Over 5000 h	5000 h	5000 h	5000 h

[a]Ratio of thermal radiation output to energy input (elements only).
[b]May be shielded from wind effects by louvers, deep-drawn fixtures, or both.
[c]May be provided with special internal supports for other than horizontal use.

Metal sheath infrared radiation elements (Figure 2A) are composed of a nickel-chromium heating wire embedded in an electrical insulating refractory, which is encased by a metal tube. These elements have excellent resistance to thermal shock, vibration, and impact, and can be mounted in any position. At full voltage, the elements attain a sheath surface temperature of 650 to 980°C. Higher temperatures are attained by configurations such as a hairpin shape. These units generally contain a reflector, which directs radiation to the load. Higher radiosity is obtained if the elements are shielded from wind because the surface-cooling effect of the wind is reduced.

Reflector lamp infrared radiation heaters (Figure 2B) have a coiled tungsten filament, which approximates a point source radiator. The filament is enclosed in a clear, frosted, or red heat-resistant glass envelope, which is partially silvered inside to form an efficient reflector. Units that may be screwed into a light socket are common.

Quartz tube infrared radiation heaters (Figure 2C) have a coiled nickel-chromium wire lying unsupported within an unevacuated, fused quartz tube, which is capped (not sealed) by porcelain or metal terminal blocks. These units are easily damaged by impact and vibration but stand up well to thermal shock and splashing. They must be mounted horizontally to minimize coil sag, and they are usually mounted in a fixture that contains a reflector. Normal operating temperatures are from 700 to 980°C for the coil and about 650°C for the tube.

Tubular quartz lamp units (Figure 2D) consist of a 9.7 mm diameter fused quartz tube containing an inert gas and a coiled tungsten filament held in a straight line and away from the tube by tantalum spacers. Filament ends are embedded in sealing material at the ends of the envelope. Lamps must be mounted horizontally, or nearly so, to minimize filament sag and overheating of the sealed ends. At normal design voltages, quartz lamp filaments operate at about 2230°C, while the envelope operates at about 590°C.

Oil Infrared

Oil-fired infrared radiant heaters are similar to gas-fired indirect infrared radiant heaters (Figures 1A, 1B, and 1C). Oil-fired units are vented.

3. SYSTEM EFFICIENCY

Because many factors contribute to the performance of a specific infrared radiant heating system, a single criterion should not be used to evaluate comparable systems. Therefore, at least two of the following indicators should be used when evaluating system performance.

Thermal radiation-energy input ratio is the thermal energy transferred by radiation in the infrared wavelength spectrum divided by the total energy input.

Fixture efficiency is an index of a fixture's ability to radiate thermal energy from the source; it is usually based on total energy input. The housing, reflector, and other parts of a fixture absorb some infrared energy and convert it to heat, which is lost through convection. A fixture that controls direction and distribution of energy effectively may have higher fixture efficiency.

Pattern efficiency is an index of a fixture's effectiveness in directing infrared energy into a specific pattern. This effectiveness, plus effective application of the pattern to the thermal load, influences the system's total effectiveness (Boyd 1963). Typical thermal radiation-energy input ratios of gas infrared heaters are shown in Table 1. Limited test data indicate that the amount of thermal radiation from gas infrared units ranges from 35 to 60% of the amount of convective heat. The Stefan-Boltzmann law can be used to estimate thermal radiation if reasonably accurate values of true surface temperature, emitting area, and surface emittance are available (DeWerth 1960). DeWerth (1962) also addresses the spectral distribution of energy curves for several gas sources.

Table 2 lists typical thermal radiation-energy input ratios of electric infrared heaters. Fixture efficiencies are typically 80 to 95% of the thermal radiation-energy input ratios.

Infrared heaters should be operated at rated input. A small reduction in input causes a larger decrease in radiant output because of the fourth-power dependence of radiant output on source temperature. Because a variety of infrared units with a variety of reflectors and shields are available, the manufacturers' information should be consulted.

4. REFLECTORS

Radiation from most infrared heating devices is directed by the emitting surface and can be concentrated by reflectors. Mounting height and whether spot heating or total heating is used usually determine which type of reflector will achieve the desired heat flux pattern at floor level. Four types of reflectors can be used: (1) parabolic, which produce essentially parallel beams of energy; (2) elliptical, which direct all energy that is received or generated at the first focal point through a second focal point; (3) spherical, which are a special class of elliptical reflectors with coincident foci; and (4) flat, which redirect the emitted energy without concentrating or collimating the rays.

Energy data furnished by the manufacturer should be consulted to apply a heater properly.

5. CONTROLS

Normally, all controls (except the thermostat) are built into gas-fired infrared heaters, whereas electric infrared fixtures usually have no built-in controls. Because of the effects of direct radiation, as well as higher MRT of the heated space and decreased air temperature compared to convective systems, infrared heating requires careful selection and location of the thermostat or sensor. A thermostat sensing the operative temperature rather than the air temperature is desirable; placing the thermostat or sensor in the radiation pattern increases accuracy. The nature of the system, type of infrared heaters, and nature of the thermostat or sensor dictate the appropriate approach. Furthermore, no single location appears to be equally effective after a cold start and after a substantial period of operation. To reduce high and low temperature swings, a long rather than a short thermostat cycling time is preferred. A properly sized system and modulating or dual-stage operation can improve comfort conditions.

An infrared heater controlled by low-limit thermostats can be used for freeze protection. For freeze protection systems and heat flux requirement, refer to Chapter 52 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

On gas-fired infrared heaters, a thermostat usually controls an electronic ignition system that monitors the gas flame and operates the automatic valve to provide on-off control of gas flow to all burners. For all gas-fired infrared heaters, conform to all applicable standards and codes covering proper venting, safety, and indoor air quality.

Gas and electric infrared systems for full-building heating may have a zone thermostatic control system in which a thermostat representative of one outside exposure operates heaters along that outside wall. Two or more zone thermostats may be required for extremely long wall exposures. Heaters for an internal zone may be grouped around a thermostat representative of that zone. Manual switches or thermostats are usually used for spot or area heating, but input controllers may also be used.

Input controllers effectively control electric infrared heaters having metal sheath or quartz tube elements. An input controller is a motor-driven cycling device in which *on* time per cycle can be set. A 30 s cycle is normal. When a circuit's capacity exceeds an input controller's rating, the controller can be used to cycle a pilot circuit of contactors adequate for the load.

Input controllers work well with metal sheath heaters because the sheath mass smooths the pulses into even radiation. The control method decreases the efficiency of infrared generation slightly. When controlled with these devices, quartz tube elements, which have a warm-up time of several seconds, have perceptible but not normally disturbing pulses of infrared, with only moderate reduction in generation efficiency.

Input controllers should not be used with quartz lamps because the cycling luminosity would be distracting. Instead, quartz lamp output can be controlled by changing the voltage applied to the lamp element, using modulating transformers or by switching the power supply from hot-to-hot to hot-to-ground potential.

Electrical power consumed by the tungsten filament of the quartz lamp varies approximately as the 1.5 power of the applied voltage, whereas that of metal sheath or quartz tube elements (using nickel-chromium wire) varies as the square of the applied voltage. Multiple circuits for electric infrared systems can be manually or automatically switched to provide multiple stages of heat. Three circuits or control stages are usually adequate. For areas with fairly uniform radiation, one circuit should be controlled with input control or voltage variation control on electric units, while the other two are full on or off control. This arrangement gives flexible, staged control with maximum efficiency of infrared generation. The variable circuit alone provides zero to one-third capacity. Adding another circuit at full on provides one-third to two-thirds capacity, and adding the third circuit provides two-thirds to full capacity.

6. PRECAUTIONS

Precautions for applying infrared heaters include the following:

- All infrared heaters covered in this chapter have high surface temperatures when operating and should, therefore, not be used when the atmosphere contains ignitable dust, gases, or vapors in hazardous concentrations.
- Manufacturers' recommendations for clearance between a fixture and combustible material should be followed. If combustible material is being stored, warning notices defining proper clearances should be posted near the fixture.

- Manufacturers' recommendations for clearance between a fixture and personnel areas should be followed to prevent personnel stress from local overheating.
- Infrared fixtures should not be used if the atmosphere contains gases, vapors, or dust that decompose to hazardous or toxic materials in the presence of high temperature and air. For example, infrared units should not be used in an area with a degreasing operation that uses trichloroethylene unless the area has a suitable exhaust system that isolates the contaminant. Trichloroethylene, when heated, forms phosgene (a toxic compound) and hydrogen chloride (a corrosive compound).
- Humidity must be controlled in areas with unvented gas-fired infrared units because water formed by combustion increases humidity. Sufficient ventilation (NFPA 54 [ANSI Z223.1], *National Fuel Gas Code*), direct venting, or insulation on cold surfaces helps control moisture problems.
- Lamp holders and electrical grounding for infrared heating lamps should comply with Section 422-15 of the *National Electrical Code*® (NFPA *Standard* 70).
- Sufficient makeup air (NFPA 54, *National Fuel Gas Code*) must be provided to replace the air used by combustion heaters, regardless of whether units are direct vented.
- If unvented combustion infrared heaters are used, the area must have adequate ventilation to ensure that combustion products in the air are held to an acceptable level (Prince 1962). See Chapter 47 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for information on IAQ concerns.
- For comfort in areas such as hangars and docks, conditioned space should be protected from substantial wind or drafts. Suitable wind shields seem to be more effective than increased radiation heat flux (Boyd 1960).

In the United States, refer to Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) guidelines for additional information. For nonvented infrared radiant heaters, IAQ and occupant comfort are important. For IAQ concerns, see Chapter 47 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

7. MAINTENANCE

Gas- and oil-fired infrared heaters require periodic cleaning to remove dust, dirt, and soot. Reflecting surfaces must be kept clean to remain efficient. Annual cleaning of heat exchangers, radiating surfaces, burners, and reflectors with compressed air is usually sufficient. Chemical cleaners must not leave a film on reflector surfaces.

Air ports of gas-fired units should be kept free of lint and dust. The nozzle, draft tube, and nose cone of oil-fired unit burners are designed to operate in a particular combustion chamber, so they must be replaced carefully when they are removed.

Electric infrared heaters require little care beyond cleaning the reflectors. Quartz and glass elements must be handled carefully because they are fragile, and fingerprints must be removed (preferably with alcohol) to prevent etching at operating temperature, which causes early failure.

8. DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS FOR BEAM RADIANT HEATERS

The effective radiant flux (ERF) represents the radiant energy absorbed by an occupant from all temperature sources different from the ambient. ERF is defined as

$$\text{ERF} = h_r(\bar{t}_r - t_a) \tag{1}$$

where

ERF = effective radiant flux, W/m^2
h_r = linear radiation heat transfer coefficient, W/(m$^2 \cdot$ K)
$\bar{t}_r$ = mean radiant temperature affecting occupant, °C
t_a = ambient dry-bulb air temperature near occupant, °C

ERF may be measured as the heat absorbed at the skin-clothing surface from a beam heater treated as a point source:

$$\text{ERF} = \frac{\alpha_K I_K (A_p/d^2)}{A_D} \tag{2}$$

where

α_K = absorptance of skin-clothing surface at emitter temperature (Figure 3), dimensionless
I_K = irradiance from beam heater, W/sr
A_p = projected area of occupant on plane normal to direction of heater beam, m^2
d = distance from beam heater to center of occupant, m
A_D = body surface area of occupant, m^2

A_p/d^2 is the solid angle subtended by the projected area of the occupant from the beam heater. The value of the DuBois area A_D has been defined as follows:

$$A_D = 2.13 W^{0.425} H^{0.725}$$

where

W = mass of occupant, kg
H = height of occupant, m

Two radiation area factors are defined as

$$f_{eff} = A_{eff}/A_D \tag{3}$$

$$f_p = A_p/A_{eff} \tag{4}$$

where A_{eff} is the effective radiating area of the total body surface. Equation (2) becomes

$$\text{ERF} = \alpha_K f_{eff} f_p I_K / d^2 \tag{5}$$

Fanger (1972) developed precise optical methods to evaluate the angle factors f_{eff} and f_p for both sitting and standing positions and for males and females. An average value for f_{eff} of 0.71 for both sitting and standing is accurate within ±2%. Variations in angle factor f_p over various azimuths and elevations for seated and standing positions are illustrated in Figures 4 and 5, and according to Fanger, apply equally to both males and females.

Manufacturers of infrared heaters usually supply performance specifications for their equipment (Gagge et al. 1967). Design information on sizing infrared heating units is also available (Howell and Suryanarayana 1990), as is the relation between color temperature of heaters and the applied electric potential (voltage) or electrical power. Gas-fired radiators usually operate at constant source temperatures of 725 to 925°C (1000 to 1200 K). Figure 3 relates the

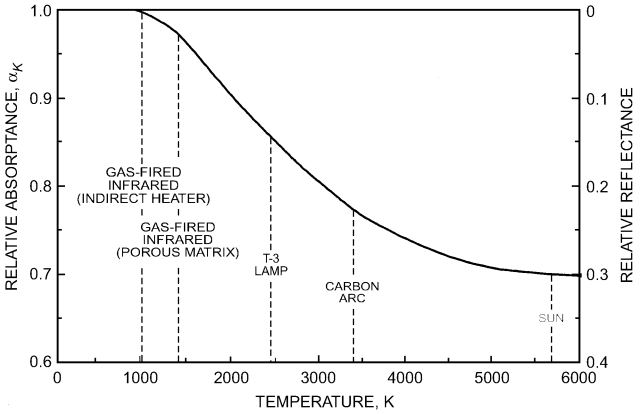

Fig. 3 Relative Absorptance and Reflectance of Skin and Typical Clothing Surfaces

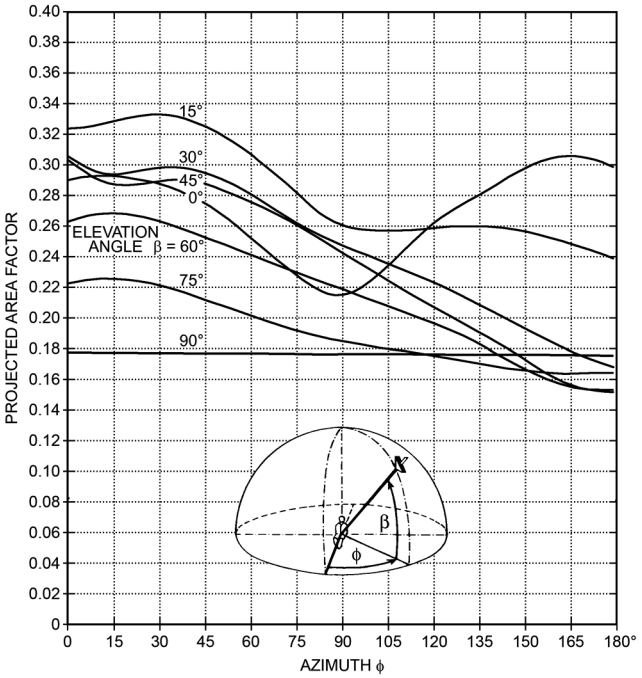

Fig. 4 Projected Area Factor for Seated Persons, Nude and Clothed

(Fanger 1972)

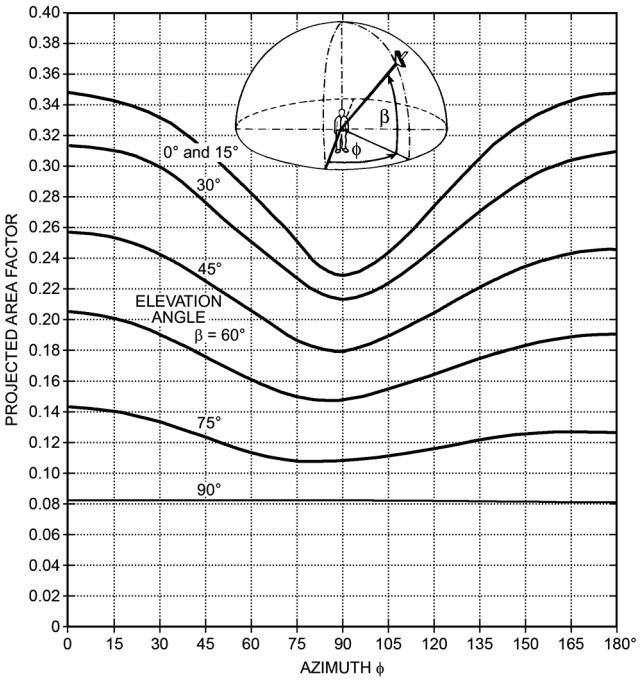

Fig. 5 Projected Area Factor for Standing Persons, Nude and Clothed

(Fanger 1972)

absorptance α_K to the radiating temperature of the radiant source. Manufacturers also supply the heat flux distribution of beam heaters with and without reflectors. Figures 6 to 9 illustrate the heat flux distribution for four typical electric and gas-fired radiant heaters. Generally, in electrical beam heaters, 70 to 80% of the total heat transfer occurs by thermal radiation, in contrast to 40% for gas-fired

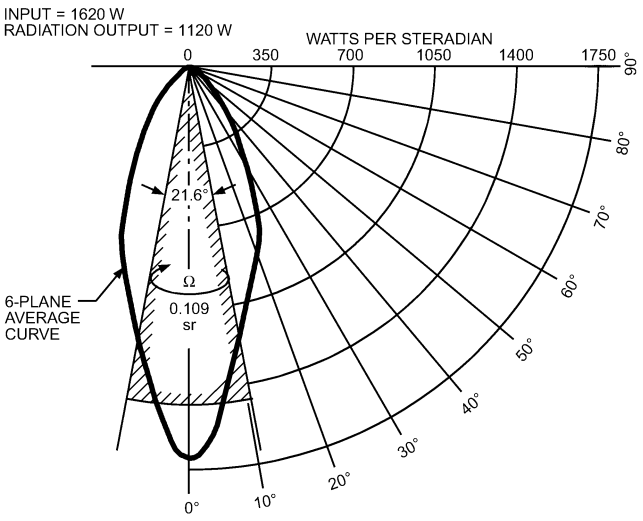

Fig. 6 Radiant Heat Flux Distribution Curve of Typical Narrow-Beam High-Intensity Electric Infrared Heaters

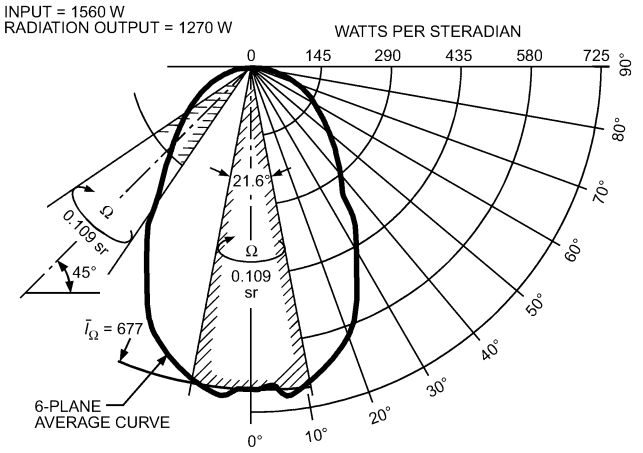

Fig. 7 Radiant Heat Flux Distribution Curve of Typical Broad-Beam High-Intensity Electric Infrared Heaters

types. In practice, the designer should choose a beam heater that will illuminate the subject with acceptable uniformity. Even with complete illumination by a beam 0.109 sr (21.6°) wide, Figure 6 shows that only 8% (100 × 1225 × 0.109/1620) of the initial electrical power input to the heater is usable for specifying the necessary I_K in Equation (5). The corresponding percentages for Figures 7, 8, and 9 are 5%, 4%, and 2%, respectively. The last two are for gas-fired beams.

The input energy to the beam heater not used for directly irradiating the occupant ultimately increases the ambient air temperature and mean radiant temperature of the heated space This increase will reduce the original ERF required for comfort and acceptability. The continuing reradiation and convective heating of surrounding walls and the presence of air movement make precise calculations of radiant heat exchange difficult.

The basic principles of beam heating are illustrated by the following examples.

Example 1. Determine the irradiance required for comfort from a quartz lamp (Figure 6) when the worker is sedentary, lightly clothed

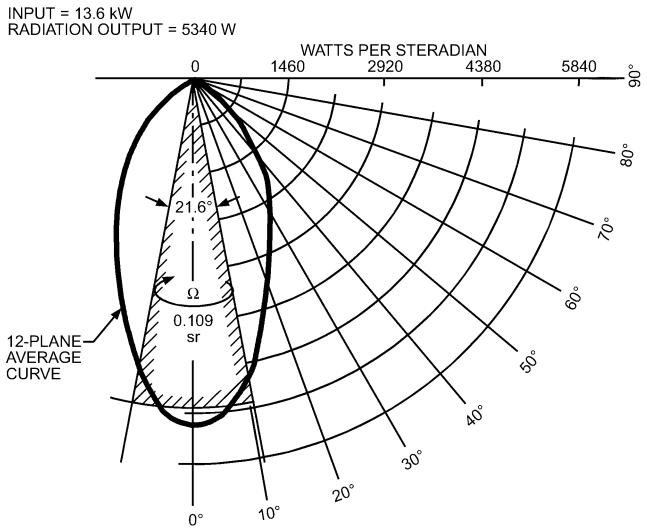

Fig. 8 Radiant Heat Flux Distribution Curve of Typical Narrow-Beam High-Intensity Atmospheric Gas-Fired Infrared Heaters

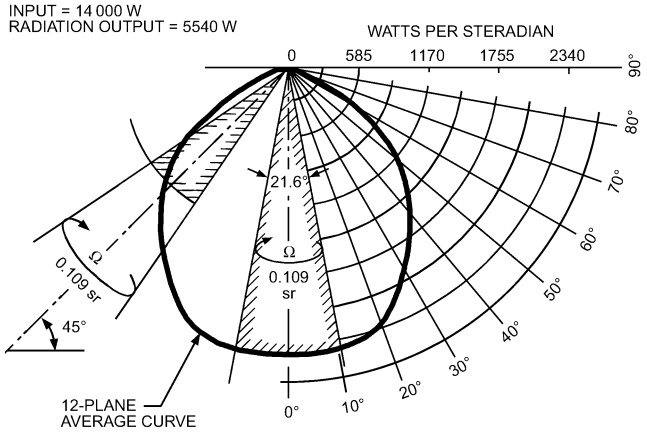

Fig. 9 Radiant Heat Flux Distribution Curve of Typical Broad-Beam High-Intensity Atmospheric Gas-Fired Infrared Heaters

[0.09 ($m^2 \cdot K$)/W], and seated. The dry-bulb indoor air temperature t_a near the occupant is 15°C, with air movement at 0.15 m/s. The lamp is mounted on the 2.4 m high ceiling and is directed at the back of the seated person so that the elevation angle β is 45° and the azimuth angle ϕ is 180°. Assume the ambient and mean radiant temperatures of the unheated space are equal. The lamp operates at 240 V and has a source temperature of 2500 K.

Solution: The ERF for comfort can be calculated as 65.3 W/m^2. α_K = 0.85 at 2500 K (from Figure 3); f_{eff} = 0.71; f_p = 0.17 (Figure 3); d = 2.4 – 0.6 = 1.8 m, where 0.6 m is sitting height of occupant.

From Equation (5), the irradiance I_K from the beam heater necessary for comfort is

$$I_K = \text{ERF}(d^2/\alpha_K f_{eff} f_p) = 65.3(1.8)^2/(0.85 \times 0.71 \times 0.17) = 2062 \text{ W/sr}$$

Example 2. For the same occupant in Example 1, when two beams located on the ceiling and operating at half of rated voltage are directed downward at the subject at 45° and at azimuth angle 90° on each side, what would be the I_K required from each heater?

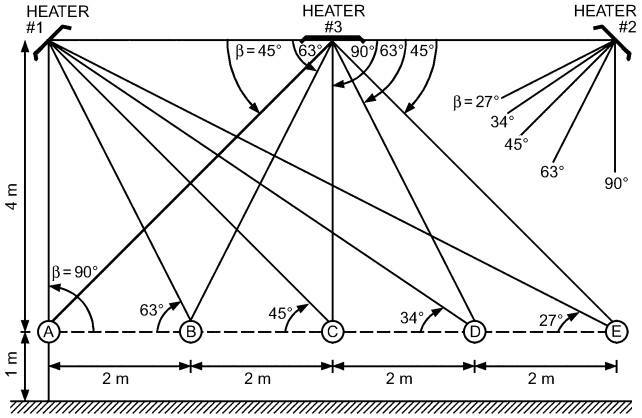

Fig. 10 Calculation of Total ERF from Three Gas-Fired Heaters on Worker Standing at Positions A Through E

Solution: The ERF for comfort from each beam is 65.3/2 = 32.6 W/m^2. The value of f_p is 0.25 (from Figure 3). At half power, V = 170, $K \cong 2000$, and $\alpha_K \approx 0.9$. Hence, the required irradiation from each beam is

$$I_K = 32.6(1.8)^2/(0.9 \times 0.71 \times 0.25) = 661 \text{ W/sr}$$

This estimate indicates that two beams similar to Figure 7, each operating at half of rated power, can produce the necessary ERF for comfort. A comparison between the I_K requirements in Examples 1 and 2 shows that irradiating a sitting person from the back is much less efficient than irradiating from the side.

Example 3. A broad-beam gas-fired infrared heater is mounted 5 m above the floor. The heater is directed 45° downward toward a standing subject 4 m away (see Heater #1 in Figure 10, position C).

Question (1): What is the resulting ERF from the beam acting on the subject?

Solution: From Equation (5),

$$\text{ERF} = \alpha_K f_{eff} f_p I_K / d^2 = 13.1 \text{ W/m}^2$$

where

α_K = 0.97 (Figure 3)
f_{eff} = 0.71
f_p = 0.26 (Figure 5 at β = 45° and ϕ = 0°)
I_K = 2340 W/sr (Figure 9)
$d^2 = 4^2 + 4^2 = 32$ m^2(center of standing subject is 1 m above floor)

If the heater were 3 m above the center of the standing subject (4 m above floor), the ERF would be 16.8 W/m^2.

Question (2): How does the ERF vary along the 0° azimuth, every 2 m beginning at a point directly under Heater #1 (Figure 10) and for elevations β = 90° at A, 63.4° at B, 45° at C, 33.6° at D, and 26.6° at E? From Figure 9, the values for f_p for the five positions are (A) 0.08, (B) 0.19, (C) 0.26, (D) 0.30, and (E) 0.33.

Solution: Because the beam is directed 45° downward, the respective deviations from the beam center for a person standing at the five positions A through E are 45°, 18.4°, 0°, 11.4°, and 18.4°; the corresponding I_K values from Figure 9 are 1460, 2340, 2340, 2340, and 2340 W/sr. The respective d^2 are 16, 20, 32, 52, and 80 m^2. The ERFs for a person standing in the five positions are (A) 5, (B) 15.5, (C) 13, (D) 9.5, and (E) 6.5 W/m^2 (rounding to the nearest 0.5 W/m^2).

Question (3): How will the total ERF at each of the five locations A through E vary if two additional heaters (#2 and #3 in Figure 10) are added 5 m above the floor over positions C and E? The center heater is directed downward, the outer one directed as above, 45° towards the center of the heated space.

Solution: At each of five locations in the heated space (A, B, C, D, E), add the ERF from each of the three radiators to determine the total ERF affecting the standing person.

A	5 + 8 + 6.5	or	19.5
B	15.5 + 13.5 + 9.5	or	38.5
C	13 + 8 + 13	or	34
D	9.5 + 13.5 + 15.5	or	38.5
E	6.5 + 8 + 5	or	19.5

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CHAPTER 17

GERMICIDAL ULTRAVIOLET LAMP SYSTEMS

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ULTRAVIOLET (UV) energy is a form of electromagnetic radiation with a wavelength shorter than that of visible light, but longer than x-rays. UV radiation is present in sunlight and constitutes about 10% of the total electromagnetic radiation output from the sun. The UV wavelength spectrum can be subdivided into following ranges and bands within the range:

- UV-A (long-wave; 400 to 315 nm)
- UV-B (medium-wave; 315 to 280 nm)
- UV-C (short-wave; 280 to 100 nm): the most effective wavelengths for germicidal control
  - Wavelengths between 200 and 230 nm are typically called **far UV**
  - **Vacuum UV** is below about 180 nm and produced with a vacuum apparatus; significant ozone (O_3) generation can occur

Although the sun emits all UV wavelengths, UV-C and lower wavelengths are blocked by the ozone layer in the earth's atmosphere. Thus, UV-C wavelengths for practical use are produced by germicidal UV sources such as lamps.

UV below 240 nm can lead to ozone formation in the air. Care must be taken, and caution is urged when using UV products operating near this wavelength band.

Use of UV lamps and lamp systems to disinfect surfaces, room air, and airstreams dates to about 1900; see Reed (2010), Riley (1988) and Schechmeister (1991) for extensive reviews of UV disinfection. Early work established that the most effective UV wavelength range for inactivation of microorganisms was between 220 to 300 nm, with peak effectiveness near 265 nm. UV was used during the polio outbreak of the 1950s and the *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* (TB) outbreak of the 1990s; the COVID-19 pandemic led to renewed interest in UV technology.

UV-C energy disrupts the DNA and RNA of a wide range of microorganisms, rendering them harmless (Brickner et al. 2003; CIE 2003). Figure 1 shows the relative effectiveness of UV-C energy at various wavelengths to cause DNA damage in a representative common bacterium; effectiveness is not significantly different for other bacteria and viruses. Most commercially available UV-C lamps are low-pressure mercury lamps that emit at least 90% of their UV energy at 253.7 nm, close to the optimal wavelength.

Germicidal ultraviolet (GUV) in the UV-C band has been used in air ducts, air-handling units, upper-room, and mobile UV-C applications for some time, and its use is becoming increasingly frequent as concern about energy, maintenance, and indoor air quality increases. UV-C energy is used as an engineering control to interrupt the transmission of pathogenic organisms, such as *Mycobacterium tuberculosis* (TB), influenza viruses, fungi, and possible bioterrorism agents (Brickner et al. 2003; CDC 2002, 2005; GSA 2003; IES 2022). In addition, it has been used extensively to irradiate air-conditioning cooling coils to remove biofilms, maintain cleanliness, and provide energy savings.

This chapter includes a review of the fundamentals of UV-C energy's impact on microorganisms; how UV-C lamps generate germicidal ultraviolet energy; the various components that comprise UV-C devices and systems; and a review of human safety and maintenance issues.

1. TERMINOLOGY

ACGIH. The American Conference of Governmental Industrial Hygienists; a professional association of industrial hygienists and practitioners of related professions.

Burn-in time. Period of time that UV lamps are powered on before they reach stable output, typically 100 h for mercury lamps.

CIE. Commission Internationale de l'Eclairage (International Commission on Illumination); an independent, nonprofit organization dedicated to the science and art of light and lighting, color and vision, photobiology, and image technology; recognized by ISO as an international standardization body.

Droplet nuclei. Airborne particles formed from evaporation of fluids emitted from infected hosts when they cough, sneeze, or talk, containing bacteria or viruses able to transmit disease from person to person. Droplet nuclei generally have an aerodynamic diameter less than 5 μm, which allows them to remain suspended in air for long periods; thus, they can be carried on normal air currents in a room

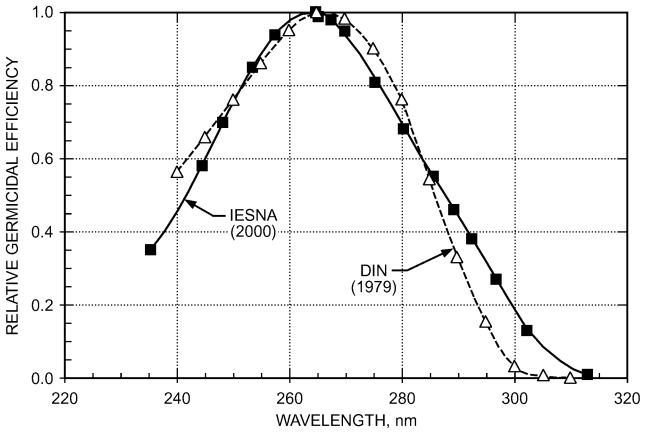


Fig. 1 Standardized DNA Germicidal Response Curve

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 2.9, Ultraviolet Air and Surface Treatment.

and beyond to adjacent spaces. When inhaled, droplet nuclei can penetrate into the alveolar region of the lung.

Erythema (actinic). Reddening of the skin, with or without inflammation, caused by the actinic effect of solar radiation or artificial optical radiation. See CIE (1987) for details. (Nonactinic erythema can be caused by various chemical or physical agents.)

Exposure. Being subjected to something (e.g., infectious agents, irradiation, particulates, and/or chemicals) that could have harmful effects. For example, a person exposed to *M. tuberculosis* does not necessarily become infected.

Exposure dose. Radiant exposure (J/m^2, unweighted) incident on biologically relevant surface.

Fluence. Radiant flux passing from all directions through a unit area in J/m^2 or J/cm^2; includes backscatter (reflection).

Germicidal radiation. Optical radiation able to inactivate microorganisms.

GUV (germicidal UV). Common term used to describe UVGI.

Irradiance. Power of electromagnetic radiation incident on a surface per unit surface area, typically reported in microwatts per square centimeter ($\mu W/cm^2$). See CIE (1987) for details.

***Mycobacterium tuberculosis*.** The namesake member of the *M. tuberculosis* complex of microorganisms, and the most common cause of tuberculosis (TB) in humans. In some instances, the species name refers to the entire *M. tuberculosis* complex, which includes *M. bovis*, *M. africanum*, *M. microti*, *M. canettii*, *M. caprae*, and *M. pinnipedii*.

NIOSH. National Institute for Occupational Safety and Health; the U.S. federal agency responsible for researching and making recommendations to prevent work-related injury and illness.

Optical radiation. Electromagnetic radiation at wavelengths between x-rays ($\lambda \approx 1$ nm) and radio waves ($\lambda \approx 1$ mm). See CIE (1987) for details.

Peak/center wavelength. Wavelength at which a UV-C source emits the most intense germicidal energy.

Permissible exposure time (PET). Calculated time period that humans, with unprotected eyes and skin, can be exposed to a given level of UV irradiance without exceeding the NIOSH recommended exposure limit (REL) or ACGIH Threshold Limit Value® (TLV®) for UV radiation.

Personal protective equipment (PPE). Protective clothing, helmets, goggles, respirators, or other gear designed to protect the wearer from injury from a given hazard, typically used for occupational safety and health purposes.

Photokeratitis. Defined by CIE (1993) as corneal inflammation after overexposure to ultraviolet radiation.

Photoconjunctivitis. Defined by CIE (1993) as a painful conjunctival inflammation that may occur after exposure of the eye to ultraviolet radiation.

Photokeratoconjunctivitis. Inflammation of cornea and conjunctiva after exposure to UV radiation. Wavelengths shorter than 320 nm are most effective in causing this condition. The peak of the action spectrum is approximately at 270 nm. See CIE (1993) for details. *Note:* Different action spectra have been published for photokeratitis and photoconjuctivitis (CIE 1993); however, the latest studies support the use of a single action spectrum for both ocular effects.

REL. Recommended exposure limit for occupational exposure to UV radiation.

Spectral distribution. Distribution of radiant power across a range of wavelengths.

Threshold Limit Value® (TLV®). An exposure level under which most people can work consistently for 8 h a day, day after day, without adverse effects. Used by the ACGIH to designate degree of exposure to contaminants. TLVs are listed either for 8 h as a time-weighted average (TWA) or for 15 min as a short-term exposure limit (STEL).

Ultraviolet radiation. Optical radiation with a wavelength shorter than that of visible radiation. (See CIE [1987] for details.) The range between 100 and 400 nm is commonly subdivided into

UV-A 315 to 400 nm
UV-B 280 to 315 nm
UV-C 100 to 280 nm

Ultraviolet germicidal irradiation (UVGI). Use of ultraviolet C-band energy to kill or inactivate microorganisms. UVGI is generated by UV-C lamps that kill or inactivate microorganisms by emitting ultraviolet radiation, predominantly at a wavelength of 253.7 nm.

UV-C LED. Light-emitting diode that emits ultraviolet-C (UV-C) radiation.

UV dose. Product of UV irradiance and exposure time on a given microorganism or surface, typically reported in millijoules per square centimetre (mJ/cm^2) or microwatt seconds per square centimetre ($\mu W \cdot s/cm^2$).

Wall plug efficiency (WPE). Total optical output power divided by the total injected electrical power.

Wavelength. Distance between repeating units of a wave pattern, commonly designated by the Greek letter lambda (λ) and typically measured in nanometres (nm).

2. GUV FUNDAMENTALS

Microbial Dose Response

GUV inactivates microorganisms by damaging the structure of nucleic acids and proteins at the molecular level, making them incapable of reproducing. Absorbed UV photons can damage DNA in various ways, but the most significant damage event is the creation of pyrimidine dimers, where two adjacent thymine or cytosine bases bond with each other instead of across the double helix as usual (Diffey 1991). In general, the DNA molecule with pyrimidine dimers is unable to function properly, resulting in the organism's inability to replicate or even its death (Diffey 1991; Miller et al. 1999; Setlow 1997; Setlow and Setlow 1962). An organism that cannot reproduce is no longer capable of causing disease (Martin et al. 2008).

The survival fraction of a microbial population exposed to UV-C energy is an exponential function of dose:

$$N_t/N_0 = \exp(-kE_{eff}\Delta t) = \exp(-k \times \text{Dose}) \quad (1)$$

where

N_0 = initial number of live microorganisms
N_t = number of live microorganisms after any time Δt
N_t/N_0 = fraction of microorganisms surviving
k = microorganism-dependent rate constant, $cm^2/(\mu W \cdot s)$
E_{eff} = effective (germicidal) irradiance received by microorganism, $\mu W/cm^2$
Dose = $E_{ff} \times \Delta t$, $(\mu W \cdot s)/cm^2$

The units shown are common, but others are used as well, including irradiance in W/m^2 and dose in J/m^2 (*note*: 1 J = 1 W · s).

Equation (1) describes an exponential decay in the number of living microorganisms at a constant level of UV-C exposure. For any application, the ability of UV-C to inactivate microogranisms is a function of **dose**, which is the irradiance received at the target area multiplied by the exposure or treatment time.

Use of Equation (1) is complicated by the movement of the target microorganisms in the airstream and the fact that the UV-C irradiance is not of constant intensity within the duct. In addition, the physical parameters of the duct, duct airflow, duct reflectance, and UV installation have the potential to affect both the irradiance and the microorganisms' response to it. As is the case with upper-room UV installation design, the design parameters for UV-C for in-duct applications are not simple because of some uncertainty in the data available to analyze them, and because of secondary effects.

A key difference between surface decontamination and airborne inactivation of organisms is exposure time. Residence time for induct devices is on the order of seconds or fractions of seconds. In a moving airstream, exposure time is limited by the effective distance in which the average irradiance was calculated; for instance, at 2.54 m/s, 0.3 m of distance takes 0.12 s. Conversely, when irradiating surfaces in an HVAC such as cooling coils, as well as upper- or whole-room air treatment UV systems, exposure time is typically continuous, so much lower levels of UV intensity are required.

Susceptibility of Microorganisms to UV Energy

Organisms differ in their susceptibility to UV inactivation; Figure 2 shows the general ranking of susceptibility by organism groups. A few examples of familiar pathogenic organisms are included in each group for information (see Table 1). Note that it is impossible to list all of the organisms of possible interest in each group. Depending on the application, consult a public health or medical professional, microbiologist, or other individual with knowledge of the threat or organism(s) of concern.

As shown in Figure 2, viruses and vegetative bacteria are the most susceptible to UV-C, followed by the *Mycobacteria*, bacterial spores, and, finally, fungal spores, which are the most resistant. In each group, an individual species may be significantly more resistant or susceptible than others, so this ranking should only be used as a rough guideline. Note that spore-forming bacteria and fungi also have vegetative states, which are markedly more susceptible to inactivation than the spores themselves. Using Equation (1), it is clear that larger values of k represent more susceptible microorganisms and smaller values represent less susceptible ones. Units of k (m^2/J) are the inverse of the units used for dose.

Using k values to design HVAC duct systems can be challenging. Values of k vary over several orders of magnitude, depending on organism susceptibility, wavelength, and values reported in the literature for the same microorganism sometimes differ greatly. An updated list of published susceptibilities of a variety of species can be found in Masjudi et al. (2021). Not that this publication uses D90 values instead of k; to convert from D90,

$$k = 2.303/\mathrm{D90}$$

The wide variation for a single-species results from several factors, the most important of which is differences in the conditions under which measurements were conducted (in air, in water, on plates). Especially for many of the vegetative organisms, the amount of protection offered by layering, organic matter, humidity, and components of ambient air can significantly affect their susceptibility to UVGI (VanOsdell and Foarde 2002). Take care when using published values, and obtain the original papers to evaluate the relevance of the k value of any particular organism to a specific application.

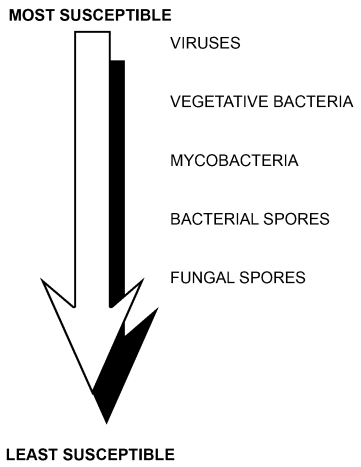


Fig. 2 General Ranking of Susceptibility to UV-C Inactivation of Microorganisms by Group

3. GERMICIDAL ULTRAVIOLET SOURCES AND EQUIPMENT

Mercury-Based Lamps

Although other options exist, currently the most energy-efficient UV-C lamps and most widely used sources are low-pressure mercury discharge lamps. These lamps contain mercury, which vaporizes when the lamp is lit. The mercury atoms accelerate because of the electrical field in the discharge colliding with the noble gas and reach an excited stage. The excited mercury atoms emit almost 85% of their energy at 253.7 nm wavelength. Very little energy is emitted in the visible spectrum, so the remaining energy results in various other wavelengths in the UV spectrum (mainly 185 nm). However, most UV-C lamps used for most applications are made with a special glass that prevents the 185 nm wavelength from being emitted from the lamp.

UV low-pressure mercury lamps exist in different shapes, which are mostly based on general lighting fluorescent lamps:

- **Cylindrical or linear** lamps may be any length or diameter. Like fluorescent lamps, most UV lamps have electrical connectors at both ends, but single-ended versions also exist. Typical diameters are 28 mm T8, 20 mm T6, and 16 mm T5.
- **U-tube** lamps have the electrical connector at one end. They have a continuously curved bend at the outer end.

UV low-pressure mercury lamps can be grouped into the following three output types:

- **Standard-output** lamps operate typically at 425 mA.
- **High-output** lamps have hot cathode filaments sized to operate from 800 up to 1200 mA. Gas mixture and pressure are optimized to deliver a much higher UV-C output while maintaining long lamp life, in the same lamp dimensions as standard-output lamps.

Table 1 Representative Members of Organism Groups

Organism Group	Member of Group
Vegetative bacteria	*Staphylococcus aureus* *Streptococcus pyogenes* *Escherichia coli* *Pseudomonas aeruginosa* *Serratia marcescens*
Mycobacteria	*Mycobacterium tuberculosis* *Mycobacterium bovis* *Mycobacterium leprae*
Bacterial spores	*Bacillus anthracis* *Bacillus cereus* *Bacillus subtilis*
Fungal spores	*Aspergillus versicolor* *Penicillium chrysogenum* *Stachybotrys chartarum*
Viruses	Influenza viruses Measles SARS Smallpox Coronavirus

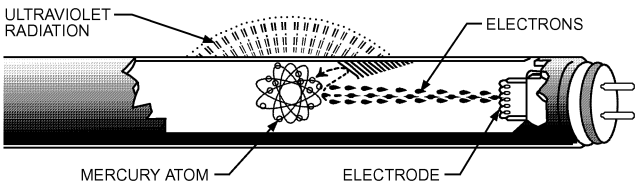


Fig. 3 Typical Hot-Cathode UVGI Lamp

- **Amalgam** lamps have hot cathode filaments sized to operate at 1200 mA or higher. The gas mixture, pressure, and sometimes lamp diameter have been optimized for delivering even higher UV output without deteriorating lamp life.

As shown in Figure 3, UV lamps use electrodes between which the electrical discharge runs and are filled with a noble gas such as argon, neon, or a mixture of the two. A small amount of mercury is present in the envelope.

Hot-cathode lamps emit electrons through thermo-ionic emission. The electrodes consist of electrical filaments coated with a special material that lowers the emission potential. The electrodes are heated by current before starting the discharge and, once started, the discharge current itself can maintain the heat. Hot-cathode lamps typically allow much higher power densities than cold-cathode lamps, and thus generate much more UV-C intensity.Though more efficient, hot-cathode lamps are sensitive to on/off cycles.

The outer envelope of UV-C lamps is made of special UV-transmitting glass or quartz. Special wires are sealed into this envelope to allow transmission of electrical energy to the electrodes, in a fashion similar to fluorescent lamps.

Two types of glass are used for UV-C lamps. Specialized soft glass is used to produce UV-C lamps that emit 253.7 nm, but the ozone-producing wavelength of 185 nm is filtered out. Quartz glass (hard) can be used to produce UV lamps either with the 253.7 nm output wavelength or with both the 185 and 253.7 nm output wavelengths by changing transmission properties of the quartz.

To maintain UV output over time, the inside of the glass/quartz tube is typically coated with a special protective layer to slow down the decrease of UV transmission over time.

Mercury can be present in UV lamps as a pure metal or as an amalgam. The amount of mercury is always (slightly) overdosed because some mercury will be chemically bound during the life of the lamp. The actual amount of mercury in the lamp varies, depending on the application, but it can be very small (less than 5 mg). An amalgam is used in lamps having a higher wall temperature because of their higher design working currents. The amalgam keeps the mercury pressure constant over a certain temperature range, providing more stable UV output over that range.

UV-C Lamp Drivers or Ballasts

All mercury gas discharge lamps, including UV lamps, require an electronic power supply (i.e., driver) or ballast to operate. The power supply provides a high initial voltage to initiate the discharge, and then rapidly limits the lamp current to safely sustain the discharge.

The ballast must match the lamp specification, especially lamp current and power. To maximize lamp lifetime, keep electrode preheating and starting conditions in mind. Electronic ballasts typically operate at high frequencies to 30 to 100 kHz. It is strongly advised to use the recommended power supply for each lamp type because less than optimum conditions will affect the lamp's starting characteristics, UV-C output, and operating life.

Circuit Type and Operating Mode. Ballasts and drivers for low-pressure mercury lamps are designed according to the following primary lamp operation modes:

- In **preheat**, lamp electrodes are heated before beginning discharge, and no auxiliary power is applied across the electrodes during operation.
- In **rapid start**, lamp electrodes are heated before and during operation. The ballasts have special secondary windings to provide the proper low voltage to the electrodes during operation. The advantages include smooth starting, longer lamp life, and dimming capabilities.
- **Program start** drivers incorporate starting steps. The first step applies voltage to electrodes until they are heated to an optimal temperature. The second step applies a lower voltage across the electrodes, thus igniting them with a minimal loss of the filaments' emissive material. This minimal loss ideally equates to a longer lamp life.
- **Instant-start** drivers do not heat the electrodes before operation. Drivers for instant-start lamps are designed to provide a relatively high starting voltage (compared to preheat and rapid-start lamps) to initiate discharge across the unheated electrodes. They are not recommended for cold-air applications or if frequent switching is needed.

Preheat mode is more efficient than rapid start, because separate power is not required to continuously heat the electrodes. Electronic drivers with preheat or program start offer smooth starting, long life, and good switching behavior.

Instant-start operation is more energy efficient than rapid or program start, but output is generally lower and lamp life can be shorter when lamps are frequently switched on and off.

Energy Efficiency. UV lamps convert roughly 30 to 40% of the input power to UV output. Additionally, some of the power supplied into a UV lamp system produces waste heat energy. There are two primary ways to improve efficiency of a UV lamp system:

- Use electronic ballasts with high efficiency
- Operate lamp(s) at their optimum temperature

Audible Noise. Because electronic high-frequency drivers have smaller magnetic components, they typically have a lower sound rating and should not emit perceptible hum. Most electronic drivers are A-rated for sound.

Electromagnetic Compatibility. Because they operate at high frequency, electronic drivers may produce electromagnetic interference (EMI), which can affect any operating frequency, or radiofrequency interference (RFI), which applies only to radio and television frequencies. This interference could affect the operation of sensitive electrical equipment, such as system controls, televisions, or medical equipment. Good-quality electronic drivers should incorporate features necessary to maximize protection for the operating environment and to operate well within regulatory limits.

Inrush Current. All electrical devices, including power supplies, have an initial current surge that is greater than their steady-state operating current. National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA) *Standard* 410 covers worst-case power supply inrush currents. All circuit breakers and light switches are designed for inrush currents. The electrical system should be designed with this issue in mind.

Total Harmonic Distortion (THD). Harmonic distortion occurs when the wave-shape of current or voltage varies from a pure sine wave. Except for a simple resistor, all electronic devices, including electromagnetic and electronic power supplies, contribute to power line distortion. THD is generally considered as the percent of harmonic current the power supply adds to the power distribution system. ANSI *Standard* C82.11 for electronic drivers specifies a maximum THD of 32%. However, most electric utilities now require that the THD of electronic drivers be 20% or less.

Dimming. Unlike other lamp designs, low-pressure mercury UV lamps can only be dimmed when electrode temperature is maintained while lamp arc current or voltage is reduced.

Electronic dimming drivers alter the output power to the lamps in the driver itself, driven by a low-voltage signal into the driver circuit. This allows control of one or more drivers independent of the electrical distribution system. With dimming electronic systems, a low-voltage control network can be used to group drivers into arbitrarily sized control zones. Dimming range differs greatly; most electronic dimming drivers can vary output levels between 100% and about 10% of full output, but drivers are also available that operate lamps down to 1% of full output.

Germicidal Lamp Cooling and Heating Effects

Output of UV lamps is dependent on mercury vapor pressure within the lamp envelope. The mercury vapor pressure is controlled by the temperature of the cold spot (the coldest portion of the UV lamp during lamp operation), as shown in Figure 4. If the mercury vapor pressure is low, UV output will be low because there are not enough mercury atoms to generate full UV radiation. Too high a mercury vapor pressure can also decrease UV output, because the excess evaporated mercury absorbs ultraviolet rays generated in the UV lamp.

In low-pressure mercury lamps, mercury vapor pressure reaches its optimal level in still air at 25°C. Depending on lamp type, the cold-spot temperature must be between 38 and 50°C to reach maximum UV output. In moving air, the cold-spot temperature of standard lamps may be too low to reach the required UV output (Figure 5). Special windchill-corrected lamps can be designed to make the lamps function more optimally in cold moving air.

By introducing mercury into the lamp in the form of amalgams, the cold-spot temperature can be increased to between 70 and 120°C, making it possible to reach optimum UV output at higher temperatures. Amalgams provide a broadened peak in UV output versus temperature, so that near-optimum UV output is obtained over an extended range of ambient temperatures.

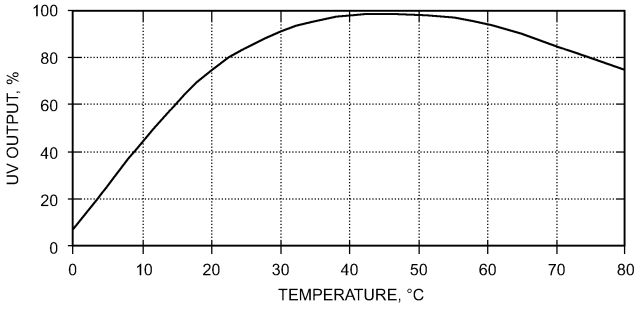


Fig. 4 Example of Lamp Output as Function of Cold-Spot Temperature

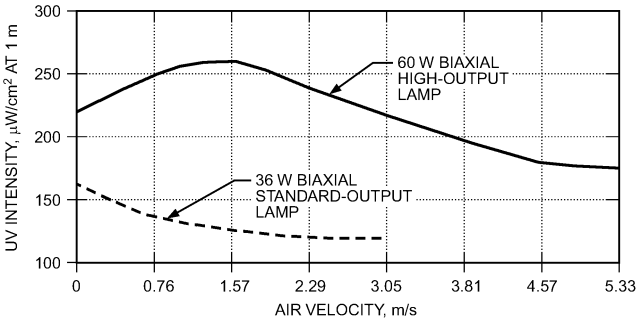


Fig. 5 Windchill Effect on Typical Low-Pressure UV-C Lamp Efficiency in Moving Airstream at 21°C

UV-C Lamp Aging

Output of UV-C lamps decreases over time. UV-C lamps are rated in effective hours of UV-C emission, and not in end of electrical life hours. Many UV-C lamps are designed to emit intensity levels at the end of their useful life that are 50 to 85% or more of that measured at initial operation (after 100 h burn-in time). Lamp manufacturers' specification data should provide information on useful life. UV-C systems should be designed for the expected output at the end of effective life or the recommended lamp change.

UV-C lamps typically have a useful lifetime of more than one year of constant operation. The useful lifetime can degrade rapidly if lamps are frequently turned on and off, however,

UV-C Lamp Irradiance

UV-C lamp intensity is measured in $\mu W/cm^2$, and manufacturers typically obtain their lamp intensity measurements by taking the UV-C intensity reading 1 m from the center of a UV lamp, in an open-air ambient of approximately 24°C and with approximately zero air movement. ASHRAE *Standards* 185.1-2015 and 185.2-2014 address test standard protocols for measuring UV-C lamp system outputs and their ability to inactivate airborne and surface microorganisms inside air-handling units, respectively.

The irradiance E on a small surface at point P on a distance a from a linear UV-C lamp length AB = L can be calculated using Equation (2) if the UV output of the lamp is represented by ϕ (Figure 6):

$$E = \frac{\phi}{2\pi^2 La}(2\alpha + \sin 2\alpha) \quad (2)$$

At shorter distances ($a < 0.5L$), the irradiance is inversely proportional to the distance of the measurement point from the lamp, as can be seen from the following simplified equation.

$$E = \frac{\phi}{2\pi La} \quad (3)$$

Induction Lamps

Induction lamps use an induced current from induction coils to maintain plasma discharge. The plasma discharge characteristics are similar to standard linear tubes, except no filament is required to produce electrons. Not having filament electrodes increases the operating lifetime to around 50,000 h (compared to around 8000 h for a filament-type bulb). Ballasts are approximately the same volume as those required for filament lamps. Lamps with electrical powers of 300 W are common, producing about 100 W of UV-C at 254 nm. Induction lamps have been shown to be very susceptible to cooling effects, as discussed previously.

Excimer Lamps (Far-UV)

Excimer lamps are relatively new types of discharge lamps that provide different UV-C wavelength choices (Blatchley 2022). The most used lamps used for germicidal applications are krypton

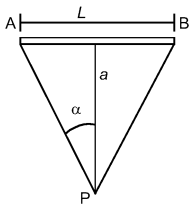


Fig. 6 Diagram of Irradiance Calculation

chloride (KrCl) lamps, predominantly emitting at 222 nm; because of their popularity in disinfecting surfaces and air in occupied spaces, this discussion applies mainly to KrCl lamps. It has been found that a narrow wavelength range of about 200 to 230 nm is significantly safer to human (and animal) skin and eyes as compared to other UV-C wavelengths. KrCl excimer lamps have the potential to eliminate microorganisms and viruses safely while people are in occupied spaces.

The emission of these excimer lamps is based on a molecular emission. The fill gas (krypton and a small amount of chlorine) forms excimer molecules (KrCl) in an electric discharge; this discharge excites these molecules, which emit UV at a molecule-specific wavelength of 222 nm. Because the chlorine would destroy electrodes (usually made of tungsten) on the inside of the discharge vessel, these lamps are electrodeless. The electrical energy is provided through the glass wall by outer electrodes.

Various lamp designs are on the marketplace. The original design consists of two axial tubes where the annular space is filled with the gas. One electrode (usually a highly reflective metal tube) is mounted on the inside, and a mesh electrode on the outside (Figure 7A). Depending on lamp power, tube diameters of 25 to 40 mm and lamp lengths of 100 to 300 mm are typical.

Another type is provided as a whole module, including an optical filter, consisting of up to four single-tube bulbs (Figure 7B). Two electrodes supply energy along the axis of the bulbs, provide cooling, and reflect light to the front of the module. These lamps have a (total) power of 12 W and a size of about 60 × 60 mm.

A third type is a flat micro plasma lamp, where discharge occurs between two flat plates separated by a much smaller distance than in the other types (Figure 7C). The metal electrodes are printed on the front and back sides of the lamp. The power range varies between 5 and 70 W, and the size varies accordingly.

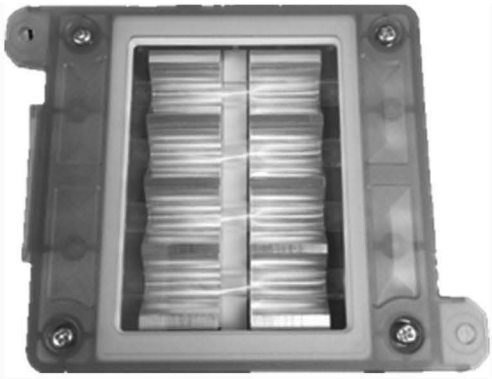
The spectrum of a KrCl lamps shows a (relatively) strong peak at 222 nm and lower continuum emission up to 270 nm, with a peak at 258 nm. The ratio of the continuum to the 222 nm line depends on lamp design and varies between manufacturers. Note that the visual appearance of the operating lamps can vary as well, but typically they appear as pink or lightly blue.

Important: the continuum at wavelengths above 230 nm significantly influences the photobiological safety rating of these lamps (see the section on Safety). For highest safety, it is recommended that occupied applications use only filtered KrCl lamps that block out wavelengths greater than 230 nm (Blatchley 2022), as in Figure 8.

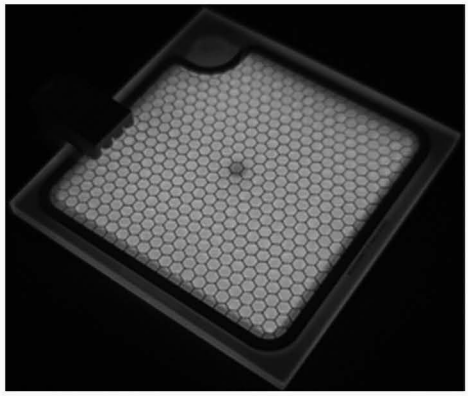
Because the lamps are filled with gas, the UV-C output is instant after turning them on. Depending on lamp design and driver, the output will only change by a relatively small amount while the temperature stabilizes. There are no internal electrodes, so lamp lifetime is typically not influenced by on/off cycling but varies between manufacturers. Note that visual inspection will not reveal whether a lamp is still emitting far UV-C; measurements of the output irradiance must be performed to verify proper operation.

Excimer lamps must be operated by lamp specific drivers, usually supplied by the lamp provider. The driver creates a high-output AC voltage in the range of 3000 to 10 000 V, depending on lamp type and power. Most modern drivers use pulsed output with

(A) ORIGINAL EXIMER LAMP DESIGN



(B) FOUR-TUBE EXIMER LAMP MODULE



(C) FLAT MICROPLASMA EXIMER LAMP

Fig. 7 Types of Excimer Lamps

pulse lengths of a few microseconds. Driver input voltage the driver varies by manufacturer, but most lower-power drivers operate at low-input voltage of 12 to 24 V DC. Wall-plug energy (WPE) efficiency of excimer lamps is typically less than 5%.

Measuring lamp power of excimer lamps is challenging (high voltage, short pulses, and small currents), so their power ratings typically refer to the combination of lamp and driver. In the United States, ANSI *Standard* LM93 describes these measurement methods. Additionally, since these lamps are always used in some kind of luminaire with reflectors, the measurement is limited to irradiance measurements (typically at 1 m distance). The optical power output of the lamp must be obtained by goniometer measurements. Radiometers to measure irradiance of KrCl lamps are available. It is important that the detector is calibrated to the light source that will be measured. For filtered KrCl lamps, calibration at 222 nm is usually sufficient; however, measurement error with unfiltered lamps can be unpredictably high.

Wavelengths between 100 and 240 nm (including 222 nm) radiation have been shown to create measurable amounts of ozone. The actual ozone concentration in an application depends on the output power of the lamp(s) in a room and other parameters, including the design of the lamp (see the section on Safety). It is recommended to operate KrCl lamps in well-ventilated rooms.

Pulsed Xenon Lamps

A pulsed xenon system uses a high-pressure arc chamber to ionize xenon gas through a high-voltage discharge, resulting in emission of intense bursts of broad-spectrum light typically ranging from 180 nm in the ultraviolet range to the visible and infrared range. Various xenon lamp shapes, such as linear, spiral, and U-shaped (Rehmet 1980), can be manufactured with appropriate triggering mechanisms, and the lamp envelope can be tailored to achieve different effective UV spectral cutoffs (e.g., 370, 240, 190, and 160 nm) for specific applications ranging from microbial inactivation to polymer curing. The pulsing system allows customization of pulse rates (1.5 to 100 pulses per second) and lamp duty cycles to suit specific requirements.

Pulsed xenon lamps emit light across the germicidal spectrum from 200 to 315 nm, have similar germicidal effects as mercury lamps (Linden et al. 2000), and operate with the same disinfection processes. Theoretically, the broad spectrum may result in additional damage mechanisms like photodimerization, photohydration, photo-crosslinking, and photo splitting (Harm 1980; Kowalski 2009). However, the other types of damage mechanisms do not significantly contribute to UV disinfection because single- and double-strand breaks and DNA-DNA cross-links occur only at doses that are several orders of magnitude higher than those typically used for UV disinfection (Jagger 1967; Masschelein 2002; Setlow 1996).

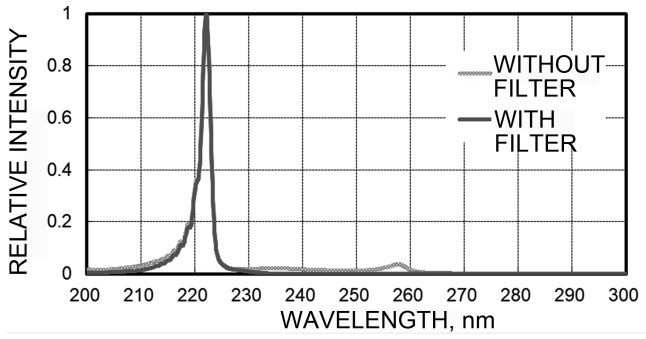


Fig. 8 Typical Spectral Distribution of Excimer Lamp with and without Filter

Pulsing and broad-spectrum light generation have various desirable properties, including high disinfection efficiency, low heat generation, lack of mercury, and rapid startup, but careful design consideration is necessary for safe application. In rooms with glass windows and doors, the bright visible light from pulsed xenon devices should be tuned to work outside the range of pulse frequencies that can trigger photoepileptic seizures in photosensitive individuals. The infrared light generated by the lamps can interfere with some devices that use non-encoded infrared light for sensing and communication. Furthermore, depending on the specific application, it is important to select pulsed xenon lamps with appropriate spectral cutoffs to mitigate the risk of ozone generation (Claus 2021).

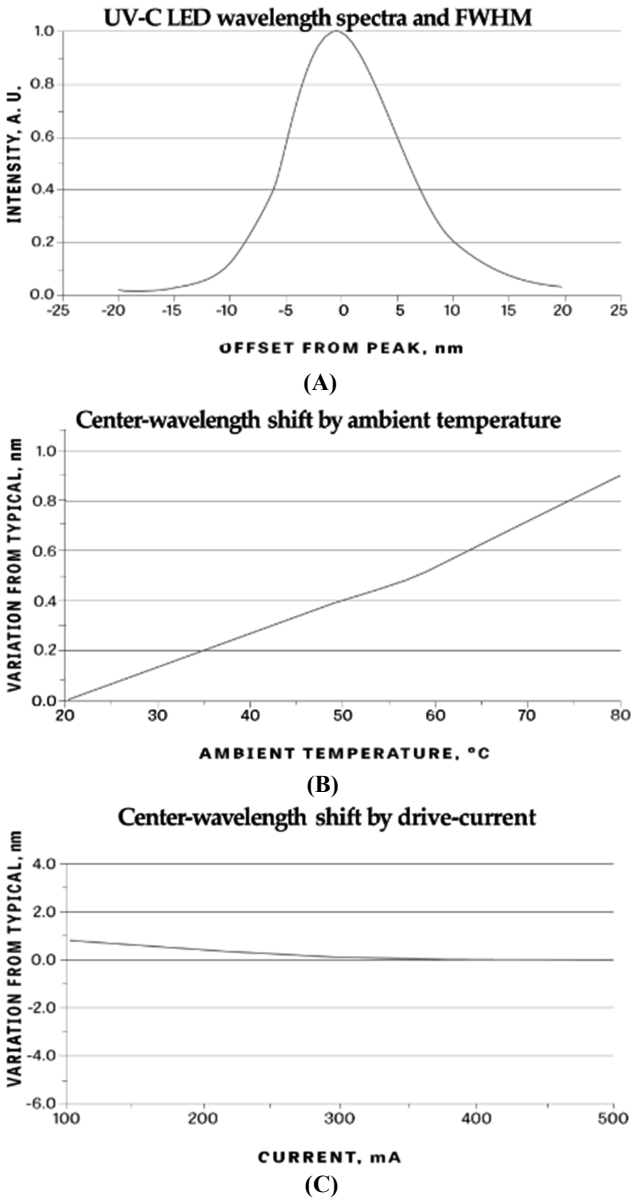


Fig. 9 Example UV-C LED Spectral Distribution, with FWHM ~12 nm and Typical Impact Shifts to Center Wavelength

4. UV-C LEDS

Commercial uses of UV-C LEDs have emerged into products and HVAC equipment for multiple germicidal applications, as well as in many non-HVAC applications. Individual LEDs are solid-state optics and optoelectrical components that, once incorporated into products, allow a wide range of capabilities and customizable performances depending on the technology, number of LEDs, positions, manner of operation, etc. UV-C LEDs can be designed for germicidal output around the peak efficiency of the standard germicidal response function (~265 nm; see Figure 1).

LEDs are made up from semiconductor materials on substrates that generate directional UV-C radiation through direct bandgap transitions. They do not require any burn-in time to stabilize output. The U.S. Department of Energy (2021, 2022) Solid State Lighting program made in-depth review of specifically AlGaN UV-C and UV-B LEDs on sapphire substrates and compared to LEDs with indium gallium nitride (InGaN) alloys common for UV-A and illumination.

The nature of LEDs makes them minuscule point-source **surface-mounted device (SMD)** components (a typical LED package size is 3.5 by 3.5 mm) to design into modules and arrays of LEDs for various germicidal purposes. The circuit board components can run both in series, in parallel, or mixed circuits. The instantaneous on/off power-switching capability (i.e., with no warm-up time delay) of such LED circuit groupings allows toggling active disinfection by duty cycling. This characteristic also simplifies exposure safety switches and can extend LED lifetime. The electrical control and drive circuit for forward voltage and drive currents can be made with simple low-voltage components, and device product designs are often engineered to run on the common low-voltage drive lines in the equipment and system without needing any additional ballasts.

UV-C LEDs allow highly customizable germicidal irradiation devices by sustainable non-hazardous materials, but the specific spectral distribution, peak wavelength, and performance characteristics differ widely across manufacturers and device design for equipment and systems.

It's also possible to combine UV-C LEDs with other pathogen mitigation technologies (e.g., photocatalytic oxidation [PCO]) when driven by UV-A LEDs irradiating a titanium dioxide (TiO_2) catalyst surface in the same compact device and board.

UV-C LED Performance Characteristics

Although UV-C LED technologies differ by their specific peak emission wavelength, spectral distribution, optical, and electrical limitations, they typically have a peak wavelength emission between 260 to 280 nm when used for germicidal applications. Both lower and higher wavelengths are possible in other applications (e.g., curing and sensors). UV-C LED components can be categorized based on their light extraction efficiency; their specified germicidal efficacy also depends on the chosen and supported drive current they operate in. For example, a UV-C LEDs on AlN substrate can be offered as part bins with either 60, 70, or 80 mW emission when operated by a 500 mA drive current. Note that the efficacy and safety of an LED peak wavelength differ from more monochromatic sources. Every LED has a spectral distribution and bandwidth (Figure 9A), thus the germicidal radiation across the actual LED emission band may be either more or less effective than their stated peak wavelength. As mentioned previously, LED outputs are measured using different techniques and test methods compared to other UV sources because LEDs are point sources, whereas lamps are line sources (see Table 4 for applicable test methods).

LED component performance can also change by integrated lenses or collar reflectors. As directional point-sources, the native conical beam shape and viewing angle in AlN UV-C LEDs is ~130°, but there is also less intense wider-angled emission that can be collimated forward with these types of optical components. Other types of LEDs can have more side emissions due to their substrate and epitaxial structure. An LED component can also host multiple LED diodes within the same SMD and optical package for added output. As with any electric circuit component, humidity and condensate risk may need consideration during design (e.g., protective enclosures or coatings), as well as circuitry self-heating and power consideration during product development for any specific application requirement.

With board modules and multiple LEDs, it is important to consider manufacturing variability between LEDs and to design for worst case to ensure intended germicidal efficacy throughout specified product life. This is especially important for UV-C LEDs with their peak wavelength situated on the slope of the standard germicidal response function curve rather than at the vertex, because variations and wavelength shifts may have big impact on germicidal performance. The width of the spectral distribution around the peak wavelength, typically noted by **full width at half maximum** (FWHM), is useful to understand how much of the broadband emission output is germicidal for any target pathogen (Figure 9A).

The peak wavelength in output can also shift by ambient temperature and designed drive current. As example, an AlN UV-C LED, can shift by 1 nm by an ambient temperature step from 20°C to 80°C (Figure 9B) and by 1 nm when lowering the drive current from 500mA to 100mA (Figure 9C).

Wall-plug efficiency (WPE) is the ratio between the electrical power going into the LED and its usable light coming out. The

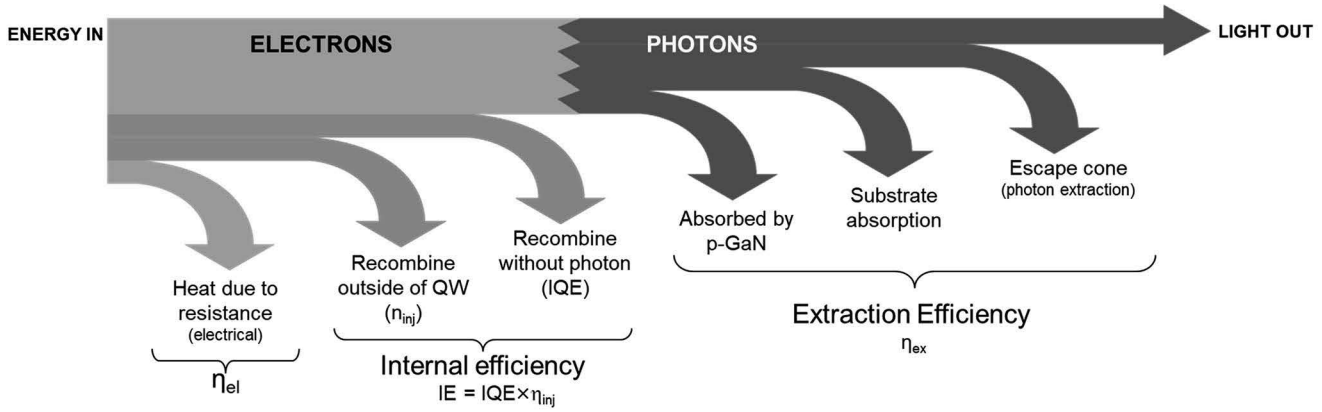


Fig. 10 Typical Loss Stages (Not to Scale) that Make up an LED's WPE

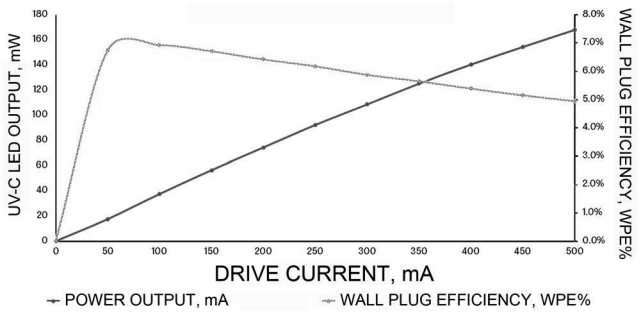


Fig. 11 Example of Effect of Drive Current on Power Output and WPE

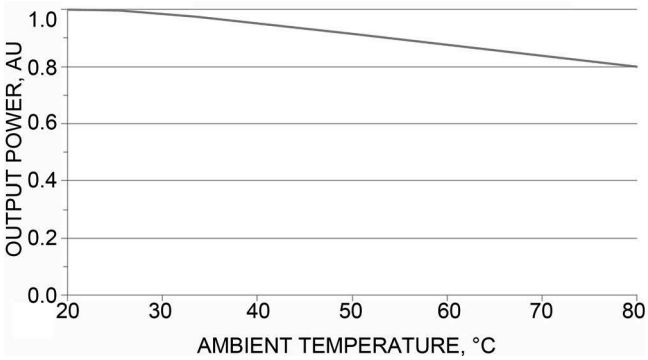


Fig. 12 Typical Effect of Ambient Temperature on Output Power

losses and efficiencies are shown in Figure 10 and differ between LED technologies. Wall-plug efficiencies are dependent on wavelength and other factors and are currently typically below 10%.

The choice of drive current also impacts the LED's WPE. For example, an AlN UV-C LED with integrated focal lens can scale from typically 20 mW germicidal radiation with 7% WPE by 50 mA drive current up to 160 mW germicidal radiation at 500 mA drive current, but the WPE is reduced to 5% (Figure 11).

Drive currents and thermal management need design consideration because of the low WPE, meaning a lot of self-heating is generated that needs to be mitigated from the electric circuit, and especially because the lifetime and radiant power output of UV-C LEDs diminish in higher temperature. As example, the germicidal radiation may drop ~20% with an ambient temperature shift from 20°C to 80°C. Consequently, placing LEDs in cold ambient air (e.g., downstream from cooling coils) or using controlled operation only during active airflow benefits their germicidal output and simplifies thermal management and heatsink design (Figure 12).

Lifetime Rating of LEDs

Manufacturers should typically specify lifetime hours data with **Life remaining (L, % transmission)** and **Batch (B, % of total LEDs)** values. L value defines the target percentage of output comparing with the initial output. B value means a target statistical confidence interval. Thus, B50 indicates that no more than 50% of LEDs would be expected to have their light output drop below the target L value maintenance level. B10 would give a duration where only 10% of the LEDs are still expected to meet the L value within the given time. For example, a rating of L70B50 as 10, 000 hours would mean that, after operating for 10, 000 hours, 50% of LEDs have dropped to 70% of their original radiant power.

Thus, LB values indicate a targeted and application-specific lifetime for maintenance use (e.g., to ensure a duration where there is adequate germicidal efficacy for a given application) and are not typically a time-to-failure after which the LED has stopped working completely.

LED lifetime is affected by the chosen drive current and how well the device's thermal management design handles the resulting junction temperatures (inner diode temperature in the depletion region where the electrons and holes recombine to generate photons) and other influences from the ambient environment. Another parameter is solder-point temperature, which is the thermal path from the SMD LED package to the soldered circuit board surface and depends on the LED package technology.

An AlN UV-C LED with L70 rated at 25, 000 hours when driven by 350 mA and a measured 35°C solder-point temperature could extend this lifetime in practice by lowering the drive current or by a more beneficial ambient environment or heatsink design.

Correctly designed and integrated, UV-C LEDs generally do not suffer detrimental impact by pulsed operation and frequent on/off power-switching. Hence, targeted L-value lifetime numbers can convert into much longer calendar lifetimes, depending on the application and duty cycling. Also, since the radiation output for germicidal dosing in equipment can be distributed across multiple contributing LEDs, adding more LEDs in design (where possible) can lower the duty cycle of each LED and yield much longer target lifetimes and replacement cycles. It is important to clarify what designed performance is expected at the end of any stated lifetime, and to understand that other components in the device (e.g., power supply, control circuits, enclosures) can affect product lifetime.

Maintenance, Monitoring, and Replacement

Despite the customization and flexibility on designing for long target lifetimes and maintenance cycles, other maintenance tasks may still be needed, such as regular cleaning of quartz windows on a UV-C LED enclosure to maintain optimal performance. Review with the manufacturer.

Engineered spectral distribution by UV-C LEDs for germicidal applications typically prevents output below ~242 nm, where ozone can start to form, so germicidal UV-C LEDs are generally not ozone generators.

Waste management or replacement of UV-C LED devices is straightforward because the LEDs themselves are considered as electronic waste.

5. UV-C PHOTODEGRADATION OF MATERIALS

UV-C energy can be detrimental to organic materials and may result in material damage or discoloration (ACGIH 2015; Bolton 2001; Kauffman 2011). Much of what is known about UV photodegradation comes from studies of sunlight, which has UV components. Unlike UV-A and UV-B, UV-C has very little penetrating power and will not penetrate through regular glass, plastic, or most solid materials. The extent of material degradation damage is a function of the material type, UV wavelength, and applied dose. Longer UV wavelengths are more penetrating, whereas shorter UV wavelengths have higher energy. Shorter UV wavelengths may also generate ozone, which can oxidize organic materials resulting in material degradation.

As such, if the UV is not applied properly and vulnerable materials are not shielded or substituted, degradation can occur (NEHC 1992). Material degradation can result in a possible loss in system performance and/or potential safety concerns. In an HVAC system, the extent of material degradation caused by UV-C energy varies greatly with type of material, UV intensity, length of exposure, and

Table 2 Summary of UV-C Resistance Ratings of Tested Materials (High UV Dose Results)

Metals and Inorganic Materials		
Rating A		
Aluminum (sheets and tape)		
Galvanized steel		
Stainless steel		
Glass fibers		
Glass		
Polymers		
Rating B	**Rating C**	**Rating D**
Polyvinyl formal (4)	Polyimide (30)	Acrylic (80)
Nylon black (10)	LDPE (30)	PET (90)
Natural nylon (10)	ABS (30)	PBT (90)
Perfluoroethylene (20)	Cast epoxy (40)	Polypropylene (200)
	Polyvinyl chloride (40)	HDPE (400)
	Polycarbonate (60)	Polyacetal (700)
	Phenolic resin	
Elastomers/Sealants		
Rating B	**Rating C**	**Rating D**
Copper/petroleum RTV		Acetic acid RTV
Latex rubber		
Buna-N O-ring		
EPDM O-ring		
Silicone O-ring		
Filter Media and Support Materials		
Rating B	**Rating C**	**Rating D**
Low-lint wipes (10)[b]	Printer paper (100)[b]	Polyester[a] (400)
Hot-melt adhesive (70)[b]	Polyurethane strips (100)[b]	Cardboard (1000)[b]
	Industrial HEPA (100-200)[b]	Lofted glass fiber[a] (7000)[b]
	HEPA consumer (200)[b]	
	Electret (300)[b]	
Miscellaneous Materials		
Rating B	**Rating C**	**Rating D**
Elastomeric isolator (30)	Polyurethane door gasket (20)	Glass fiber insulation[a] (90)
Elastomeric V-belt (70)	Mastic duct sealant (400)	Neoprene door gasket[a] (100)
		Foam pipe insulation[a] (300)
		Polystyrene foam[a] (400)

Source: Kauffman (2011, 2012, 2017). [a]Structural damage: crumbled, lost fibers, etc. [b]Slope from 10 000 μW/cm^2 test

Note:
Numbers in parentheses refer to rate of UV degradation; lower numbers indicate greater UV resistance. Parenthetical ratings are arbitrary and for relative linear comparison only.

design of the component. UV-C intensity in a system can be as high as 10 000 μW/cm^2 for airstream disinfection, or about 50 to 100 μW/cm^2 for cooling coil maintenance, although typical designs use much higher intensity. For many HVAC components, such as certain filter media and insulation or gasket foams, degradation can be rapid and severe, destroying the material (Kauffman 2011, 2012, 2017). Inorganic materials such as glass, glass fibers, and metal are not affected by UV-C exposure. The detailed data in the Kauffman studies are based on exposure to 254 nm UV wavelengths and can be used to estimate degradation of an item at different UV intensity levels and exposure times; Table 2 gives an overview that can be used to determine what materials to avoid or shield in a system.

As a general rule, solid materials performed better than porous/fibrous materials because of the minimal surface penetration by UV-C radiation. Based on the relative degradation, the materials were ranked with respect to the UV-C resistance as follows:

- A: No effect (inorganic materials only; all organic materials exhibit some degradation)
- B: Minor effect (mainly cosmetic changes, not likely to affect materials ability to perform its duty)
- C: Moderate effect (some cracking/pitting suggesting protection/shielding should be considered)
- D: Severe effect (structural damage, not recommended)

Although UV-C photodegradation is of concern, with the selection of the proper material or metallic shielding of other components, the problem can be significantly reduced and components can be expected to meet product design life. The useful life of organic materials may be extended by protecting them with UV absorbers, stabilizers, or reflective pigments or coatings.

6. MAINTENANCE

Lamp Replacement

UV lamps should be replaced at the end of their useful life, based on recommendations of the equipment manufacturer. It may be prudent to simply change lamps annually (8760 h when lamps are run continuously) to ensure that adequate UV energy is supplied. Lamps can operate long after their useful life, but with the potential of greatly reduced performance. The typical useful life of low-pressure mercury UV-C lamps is 9000 h of continuous operation but the lifetime could be impacted by power supply selection, system design, risk tolerance, or manufacturer recommendations. Switching lamps on and off too often may lead to early lamp failure, depending on the power supply type used. Consult the lamp manufacturer for specific information on expected lamp life and effects of switching.

Lamp replacement should be done wearing nitrile or latex gloves to avoid depositing oils from one's hands on the bulb envelope. Before activation, lamps should be wiped down with isopropanol after installation to remove any contaminants.

Lamp Disposal

UV lamps should be treated the same as other mercury-containing devices, such as fluorescent bulbs, according to local regulations. Most lamps must be treated as hazardous waste and cannot be discarded with regular waste. Low-mercury bulbs often can be discarded as regular waste; however, some state and local jurisdictions classify these lamps as hazardous waste. The U.S. EPA's universal waste regulations allow users to treat mercury lamps as regular waste for the purpose of transporting to a recycling facility (EPA 2011). This simplified process was developed to promote recycling. The National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA) maintains a list of companies claiming to recycle or handle used mercury lamps at www.lamprecycle.org.

Visual Inspection

Maintenance personnel should routinely perform periodic visual inspection of the UV lamp assembly. Typically, a viewing port or an access door window is sufficient for in-duct applications. Any burned-out or failing lamps should be replaced immediately.

Depending on the application and environment, a maintenance plan may need to include direct physical inspection of the fixture. If the lamp has become dirty, it should be cleaned with a lint-free cloth and commercial glass cleaner or isopropyl alcohol.

Future UV-C systems may include a feedback component to alert maintenance personnel to UV-C lamp failure or UV-C output degradation.

7. SAFETY

Hazards of Ultraviolet Radiation to Humans

UV-C is a low-penetrating form of UV compared to UV-A or UV-B. Measurements of human tissue show that 4 to 7% of UV-C (along with a wide range of wavelengths, 250 to 400 nm) is scattered (Diffey 1983) and absorbed in the first 2 μm of the stratum corneum (outer dead layer of human skin), thus minimizing the amount of UV-C transmitted through the epidermis (Bruls 1984). Far more energy is absorbed into the stratum corneum and surface cells in the far UV-C at wavelengths less than 235 nm (Finlayson 2022; Nishigori 2023).

Although UV photons are more energetic than the visible portion of the electromagnetic spectrum, UV-C and UV-B are invisible to humans. Therefore, exposure to ultraviolet energy can result in ocular damage, which may initially go unnoticed.

Ocular damage generally begins with **photokeratitis** (inflammation of the cornea), but can also result in **conjunctivitis** (inflammation of the conjunctiva [ocular lining]). Symptoms, which may not be evident until several hours after exposure, may include an abrupt sensation of sand in the eyes, tearing, and eye pain, possibly severe. These symptoms usually appear within 6 to 12 h after UV exposure, and resolve within 24 to 48 h.

Cutaneous damage consists of erythema, a reddening of the skin. It is like a mild sunburn with no tanning. The maximum effect of erythema occurs at a wavelength of 296.7 nm in the UV-B band. UV-C radiation at a wavelength of 253.7 nm is less effective, but is still an acute skin hazard.

The International Commission on Illumination (CIE) provides a thorough review of UV-C **photocarcinogenesis** risks from germicidal lamps (CIE 2010).

Acute **overexposure** to UV-C band radiation is not incapacitating unless greatly exceeding exposure guidelines, but generally regresses after several days, leaving no permanent damage.

In recent years, there has been growing interest in far UV-C (200 to 235 nm). These wavelengths show far less penetration into surface cells of the cornea and the skin.

Sources of UV Exposure

UV-C energy does not normally penetrate through solid substances and is attenuated by most materials. Quartz glass, soda barium glass, and PTFE plastic have high transmissions for UV-C radiation.

UV-C energy can reflect from most polished metals and several types of painted and nonpainted surfaces (Wengraitis and Reed 2012); however, a surface's ability to reflect visible light cannot be used to indicate its UV-C reflectance. The fact that a blue glow can be observed on the metal surface from an operating low-pressure UV fixture lamp could indicate the presence of UV, and a measurement should be performed to ensure there is no exposure risk. The lack of reflected blue light does not necessarily indicate the absence of UV energy.

Well-designed and commissioned upper-room UV-C installations, education of maintenance personnel, signage, and safety switches can avoid overexposure. During commissioning and before operation of the UV-C installation, hand-held radiometers with sensors tuned to the read the specific 254 nm wavelength should be used to measure stray UV-C energy (primarily in upper-air systems).

Exposure Limits

In 1972, the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) and National Institute for Occupational Safety and Health (NIOSH) published a **recommended exposure limit (REL)** for occupational exposure to UV radiation. REL is intended to protect workers from the acute effects of UV exposure, although photosensitive persons and those exposed concomitantly to photoactive chemicals might not be protected by the recommended standard. The American Conference of Governmental Industrial Hygienists (ACGIH) also issues similar Threshold Limit Values (TLVs®) for occupational exposure to ultraviolet radiation in the spectral region between 180 and 400 nm, and represent conditions to which nearly all workers may be repeatedly exposed without adverse health effects. The RELs and TLVs for occupational exposure to UV incident on skin or eye are based on the irradiance and time of exposure.

Table 3 lists some permissible exposure times for different levels of UV-C irradiance. Exposures exceeding CDC/NIOSH REL levels require use of personal protective equipment (PPE), which consists of eyewear and clothing known to be nontransparent to UV-C penetration and which covers exposed eyes and skin. The basic REL limit is a cumulative daily exposure of 3 mJ/cm2 (effective), which is spectrally weighted to a hazard-weighting function $S(\lambda)$. Thus, it is time-weighted and the values in Table 3 reflect a steady-state, continuous exposure for that duration. Obviously, during a day most individuals do not remain in a fixed position, so it is possible to expect a total exposure duration that is less than a full day.

Although the overall spectral ranges covered by NIOSH RELs and ACGIH TLVs differ slightly, for most practical UV-C exposures the values were identical from 1972 until the end of 2021. The updated TLVs for eye and skin safety for different wavelengths are shown in Table 4 and Figure 13 (ACGIH 2022).

UV inspection, maintenance, and repair workers typically do not remain in one location during the course of their workday, and therefore are not exposed to UV irradiance levels for 8 h. Threshold Limit Value® (TLV®) consideration should be based on occupancy use of spaces treated by UV-C systems (ACGIH 2023).

Some indoor plants do not tolerate prolonged UV-C exposure and should not be hung in the upper room if upper-air UV systems are used.

At 253.7 nm, the CDC/NIOSH REL is 6 mJ/cm^2 (6000 μJ/cm^2) for a daily 8 h work shift. ACGIH's (2023) TLV for UV radiation is identical to the REL for this wavelength. Permissible exposure

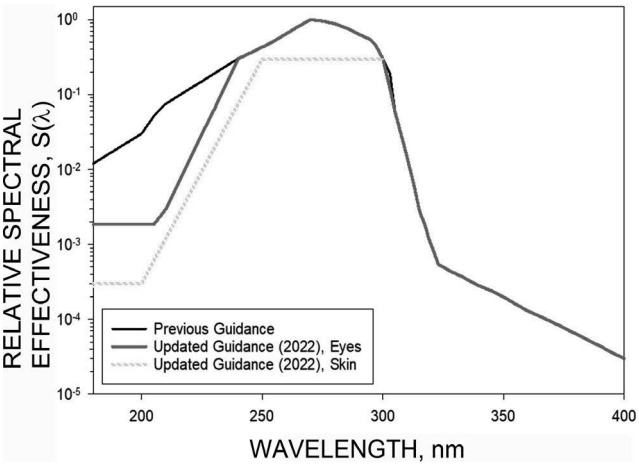


Fig. 13 Comparison of Previous and updated ACGIH Spectral Weighting Values *S*(λ) as Function of Wavelength

(ACGIH 2022)
Since revised values for eye exposure are overly protective for skin, the higher values for skin apply to conditions where the eyes are protected from direct exposure.

Table 3 Permissible Exposure Times for Given Effective Irradiance Levels of UV-C Energy at 253.7 nm

Permissible Exposure Time*	Effective Irradiance, μW/cm²
8 h	0.2
4 h	0.4
2 h	0.8
1 h	1.7
30 min	3.3
15 min	6.7
10 min	10
5 min	20
1 min	100
30 s	200
15 s	400
5 s	1200
1 s	6000

Source: ACGIH TLV® for unprotected eye. For a 222 nm lamp, TLV exceeds 150 mJ/cm² in an 8 h period.

times (PET) can be calculated for various irradiance levels using the following equation:

$$\text{PET, s} = \frac{\text{REL of 6000 } \mu\text{J/cm}^2 \text{ at 254 nm}}{\text{Measured irradiance level at 254 nm in } \mu\text{W/cm}^2} \quad (4)$$

Ozone Considerations

Some UV lamps used in the industry have spectral outputs around 185 nm and are designed to produce ozone for specific remediation applications. Adequate safety precautions are advised when using these lamps.

Excimer (far UV-C) lamps with spectral outputs around 222 nm also have the potential to generate ozone (Jiminez 2023; Link 2023). These lamps can generate ozone via photochemical reactions as well as from their corona discharge. The amount of ozone depends on the type, number, and configuration of lamps used in the application, as well as the level of ventilation, airflow, air mixing, and air exchange rate for that application (Blatchely 2022).

Upper-Room Applications

UV performance and safety levels can be measured with a calibrated UV radiometer with a cosine corrected detector. When measuring occupant safety, apply a field-of-view (FOV) hood to the detector and take the measurement directly facing the device at 1.8 m at various locations in a room or occupied space; measurements must be taken in the same location each time. If the readings indicate a dosage in constantly occupied areas exceeding 6 mJ/cm² in an 8 h period, the UV systems must be deactivated until adjustments can be made or the manufacturer can be contacted. UV-C measurements should be taken

- At initial installation
- Whenever new lamps are installed (newer lamp designs may have increased irradiance)
- Whenever modifications are made to the GUV system or room (e.g., adjusting fixture height or location or position of louvers, adding UV-absorbing or -reflecting materials, changing room dimensions or modular partition height)

Upper-air applications of GUV inevitably expose room components (walls, ceiling, louvers, lights, etc.) to strong radiation. Monitor condition of these elements to ensure that degradation has no negative effects on the facility's safety. Further guidance on GUV, including the approach to time-weighted averaging of human exposures is provided by ANSI/IES (2021).

Upper-air systems should have on/off switches and an electrical disconnect device on the louvers. If UV radiation measurement taken at initial installation exceed the recommended exposure limit, all highly UV-reflecting materials should be removed, replaced, or covered. UV-absorbing paints containing titanium oxide can be used on ceilings and walls to minimize reflectance in the occupied space. Most ceiling tiles are of relatively low reflectance (Wengraitis 2012).

Warning labels must be posted on all upper-air UV fixtures to alert personnel of potential eye and skin hazards. Damaged or illegible labels must be replaced as a high priority. Warning labels must contain the following information:

- Wall sign for upper-air UV-C
  Caution: Ultraviolet energy. Switch off lamps before entering upper room.
- General warning posted near UV-C lamps
  Caution: Ultraviolet energy. Protect eyes and skin.
- Warning posted on the door of air handlers where UV-C lamps are present in ductwork
  Warning: Ultraviolet energy in duct. Disconnect power before servicing.

In-Duct Systems

In-duct systems should be fully enclosed to prevent leakage of UV radiation to unprotected persons or materials outside of the HVAC equipment.

All access panels or doors to the lamp chamber and panels or doors to adjacent chambers where UV radiation may penetrate or be reflected should have warning labels in appropriate languages. Labels should be on the outside of each panel or door, in a prominent location visible to people accessing the system.

Lamp chambers should also have electrical disconnect devices. Positive disconnection devices are preferred over switches. Disconnection devices must be able to be locked or tagged out, and should be located outside the lamp chamber, next to the chamber's primary access panel or door. Devices should be wired in series so that opening any single access point deenergizes the entire UV system. On/off devices for UV lamps must not be installed in the same location as general room lighting; instead, they must be in a location that only authorized persons can access, and should be locked to ensure that they are not accidentally turned on or off.

Table 4 UV Radiation TLVs® and Relative Spectral Effectiveness for Eye and Skin

	Eye Safety			Skin Safety		
	TLV, J/m²	TLV, mJ/cm²	Relative Spectral Effectiveness $S(\lambda)$	TLV, J/m²	TLV, mJ/cm²	Relative Spectral Effectiveness $S(\lambda)$
200	16 300	1630	0.00184	100 000	10 000	0.000300
222	1600	160	0.01867	47 840	4784	0.000627
254	60	6.0	0.50000	100	10	0.30000
260	46	4.6	0.65000	100	10	0.30000
265	37	3.7	0.81000	100	10	0.30000
270	30	3.0	1.0000	100	10	0.30000
275	31	3.1	0.9600	100	10	0.30000
280	34	3.4	0.88000	100	10	0.30000
365	270 000	27 000	0.00011	270 000	27 000	0.00011
400	1 000 000	100 000	0.00003	1 000 000	100 000	0.00003

Source: ACGIH (2022).

UL *Standard* 1995 requires that no opening permits leakage of UV-C greater than 0.1 μW/cm², and points of intentional access to UV sources must be equipped with an interlocking mechanism that deenergizes the UV sources when opened.

The lamp chamber should have one or more viewports of UV-C-absorbing materials (ordinary glass). Viewports should be sized and located to allow an operating UV system to be viewed from outside of the HVAC equipment.

Personnel Safety Training

Workers should be provided with as much training as necessary, including health and safety training, and some degree of training in handling lamps and materials. Workers should be made aware of hazards in the work area and trained in precautions to protect themselves. Training topics should include

- UV exposure hazards
- Electrical safety
- Lock-out/tag-out
- Health hazards of mercury
- Rotating machinery
- Slippery condensate pans
- Sharp unfinished edges
- Confined-space entry (if applicable)
- Emergency procedures

Workers expected to clean up broken lamps should be trained in proper protection, cleanup, and disposal.

No personnel should be subjected to direct UV exposure in excess of current exposure guidelines, but if potentially hazardous exposure is unavoidable, personnel should wear protective clothing (no exposed skin), protective eyewear, and gloves. Most eyewear, including prescription glasses, may be sufficient to protect eyes from UV, but not all offer complete coverage (energy could still reach the eyes from the sides or reflections from inside the glasses); standard-issue, full wraparound protective goggles may be the best alternative.

If individual lamp operating condition must be observed, this should preferably be done using the viewport window(s).

Access to lamps should only be allowed when lamps are deenergized. The lamps should be turned off before air-handling unit (AHU) or fan shutdown to allow the lamps to cool. Workers should always wear protective eyewear and puncture-resistant gloves for protection in case a lamp breaks.

Access to the lamp chamber should follow a site-specific lock-out/tag-out procedure. Do not rely on panel and door safety switches as the sole method to ensure deenergized lamps. Doors may be inadvertently closed or switches may be inadvertently contacted, resulting in unexpected lamp activation.

If workers will enter the condensate area of equipment, the condensate pan should be drained and any residual water removed.

In general, avoid performing readings with the fan running and workers inside an AHU (e.g., to test for output reduction caused by air cooling). Tests of this nature should be instrumented and monitored from outside the equipment.

During maintenance, renovation, or repair work in rooms where upper-air UV systems are present, all UVGI systems must be deactivated before personnel enter the upper part of the room.

Lamp Breakage

If a mercury lamp breaks, all workers must exit the HVAC equipment. Panels or doors should be left open and any additional lamp chamber access points should also be opened. Do not turn air-handling unit fans back on. After a period of 15 minutes, workers may reenter the HVAC equipment to begin lamp clean-up.

If a lamp breaks in a worker's hand, the worker should not exit the HVAC equipment with the broken lamp. Carefully set the broken lamp down, then exit the equipment. When possible, try not to set the broken lamp in any standing condensate water. Follow standard ventilation and reentry procedures.

Cleanup requires special care because of mercury drop proliferation and should be performed by trained workers. As a minimum, workers should wear cut-resistant gloves, as well as safety glasses to protect eyes from glass fragments. Large lamp pieces should be carefully picked up and placed in an impervious bag. HEPA-vacuum the remaining particles, or use other means to avoid dust generation.

8. INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING

Ensuring the performance and safety of UVGI systems deployed at a facility is of paramount importance. It is recommended that equipment manufacturers provide complete installation details and drawings to ensure that the equipment is installed properly and operates as designed.

Currently there is no consensus guidance on the design, installation, commissioning, and certification of UVGI systems. Those currently applying it rely on various sources, including manufacturers' literature, peer-reviewed publications, and handbooks. At present, the most well-developed areas of standards related to UVGI applications are the rating of some lamps, electrical safety standards, and safe human exposure limits. NALMCO had been developing a certification for UV technicians (www.nalmco.org/guv-training). Facility managers and system installers should require detailed documentation to ensure that installed equipment performs in accordance with the specified design and meets all applicable performance and safety standards.

Note that most installed systems comprise multiple individual UV fixtures/devices; the performance and safety of the integrated

system depend on the number and configuration of these multiple fixtures in the treatment space along with their interaction with other items in that treatment space. Examples include a UV system comprising multiple fixtures used for coil cleaning or air disinfection inside HVAC units, or a room application entailing multiple upper-room or ceiling-mounted fixtures. This becomes increasingly important when considering occupied versus unoccupied spaces. Although there are certain common issues in the application of such systems, such as lamp performance and safety, the information and methods needed to validate the installed system will be different. These systems would also need to comply with any relevant standards for field installations, which are currently lacking in industry. System providers should be able to validate the system performance and safety by in-situ field testing and measurements if possible, or by providing validated mathematical modeling outputs for UV fluence, IES files (i.e., photometric data files), etc., that are specific to that installation and/or independent field or case studies validating their system. For in-duct, coil disinfection, and surface disinfection systems, a key need is accurate calculation of UV dose, which depends mainly on the radiation field in the device. For both standalone recirculating and upper-air systems, airflow patterns in the space served are also critical because they determine how effectively contaminated air is brought into the irradiation zone of the device.

The commissioning authority may require a performance and safety test on a sample installation to determine whether the system meets specifications. Measurement and monitoring of irradiance using calibrated radiometers or color change dosimeters can be used to verify installed lamp ratings or performance, check for UV leakage at the time of manufacture and as installed, verify irradiance levels on cooling coil surfaces, and verify the safety of installed UVGI systems. Broad-range UV photosensors are needed instead of narrow-band UVC sensors to accommodate the different light sources and spectral output available. Control measures such as PPE, safety interlock switches, remote operation, viewports, etc., should be implemented to ensure protection against any UV exposure above acceptable levels. The section on Safety in this chapter describes the various aspects of safety (electrical, photobiological, ozone, photochemical, photodegradation) that need to be validated and monitored for GUV systems. Control measures such as PPE, safety interlock switches, remote operation, and viewports should be implemented to ensure protection against any UV exposure above acceptable levels.

Table 5 lists performance and safety standards and guidelines that are applicable to GUV systems. In the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, see Chapter 62 for additional information on UV use, and Chapter 44 for information on building commissioning and UV systems.

Table 5 GUV Standards and Guidelines for Safety and Performance

Standard/Guideline	Description
ASHRAE 185.1	Method of Testing UV-C Lights for Use in Air-Handling Units or Air Ducts to Inactivate Airborne Microorganisms
ASHRAE 185.2	Method of Testing Ultraviolet Lamps for Use in HVAC&R Units or Air Ducts to Inactivate Microorganisms on Irradiated Surfaces
ASHRAE 185.3P (proposed)	Method of Testing In-Room Devices and Systems for Microorganism Removal or Inactivation in a Chamber
ASHRAE 185.4P (proposed)	Method of Testing In-Room Ultraviolet Devices and Systems for Microbial Inactivation on Surfaces in a Test Room
ASHRAE 241	Control of Infectious Aerosols
UL 153	Standard for Portable Electric Luminaires
UL 1598	Luminaires
UL 1995	Heating and Cooling Equipment
UL 60335-2-40	Household and Similar Electrical Appliances—Safety—Part 2-40: Particular Requirements for Electrical Heat Pumps, Air-Conditioners and Dehumidifiers
UL 60335-2-19	Outline of Investigation for Robotic Germicidal Equipment
UL 8802	Outline of Investigation for UV Germicidal Equipment and Systems
UL 8803	Outline of Investigation for Portable UV Germicidal Equipment with Uncontained UV Sources
UL 61010-10	Safety Requirements for Electrical Equipment (Healthcare and Lab Settings)
UL 2998	Environmental Claim Validation Procedure (ECVP) for Zero Ozone Emissions from Air Cleaners
IEC 62471-6	Photobiological Safety Of Lamps And Lamp Systems—Part 6: Ultraviolet Lamp Products
ISO 15714	Method of Evaluating the UV Dose to Airborne Microorganisms Transiting In-Duct Ultraviolet Germicidal Irradiation Devices
ISO 157527-20	UV-C devices—Measurement of the Output of a UV-C Lamp
ISO 15858	UV-C Devices: Safety Information
ANSI/IES RP-27	Recommended Practice for Photobiological Safety for Lamps and Lamp Systems—Measurement Techniques
ANSI/IES RP-44	Recommended Practice: Ultraviolet Germicidal Irradiation (UVGI)
ANSI/AHAM AC-5-2022	Method for Assessing the Reduction Rate of Key Bioaerosols by Portable Air Cleaners Using an Aerobiology Test Chamber
ANSI/IES LM-78	Total Luminous Flux Measurement of Lamps Using an Integrating Sphere Photometer
IES LM-79	Optical and Electrical Measurements of Solid State Lighting Products
IES LM-80	Measuring Luminous Flux and Color Maintenance of LED Packages, Arrays, and Modules
IES LM-90	Measuring Luminous Flux Waveforms for Use in Temporal Light Artifact (TLA) Calculations
ANSI/IES LM-92	Optical and Electrical Measurement of Ultraviolet LEDs
ANSI/IES LM-93	Optical and Electrical Measurements of Far UV-C Excimer Sources
GPC 37P (proposed)	Guidelines for the Application of Upper-Air (Upper Room) Ultraviolet Germicidal (UV-C) Devices to Control the Transmission of Airborne Pathogens
ASTM 3135-18	Standard Practice for Determining Antimicrobial Efficacy of Ultraviolet Germicidal Irradiation Against Microorganisms on Carriers with Simulated Soil
CSA C22.2 No. 60335-2-27	Household and Similar Electrical Appliances—Safety—Part 2- 27: Particular Requirements for Appliances for Skin Exposure to Optical Radiation
CSA C22.2 No. 187:20	Electrostatic Air Cleaners

9. UNIT CONVERSIONS

Just as it is customary to express the size of aerosols in micrometres and electrical equipment's power consumption in watts, regardless of the prevailing unit system, it is also customary to express total lamp UV output, UV fluence, and UV dose using SI units.

Multiply	By	To Obtain
I-P to SI		
Btu/ft^2 (International Table)	1135.65	mJ/cm^2
Btu/h · ft^2	315.46	μW/cm^2
SI to I-P		
mJ/cm^2	0.00088	Btu/ft^2
μW/cm^2	0.00317	Btu/h · ft^2

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CHAPTER 18

VARIABLE REFRIGERANT FLOW

Standards 18.3
Equipment 18.4
VRF System Operation 18.4
Modeling Considerations 18.8
Design Considerations 18.8
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VARIABLE-refrigerant-flow (VRF) HVAC systems are a direct-expansion (DX) heat pump technology platform built on the standard reverse Rankine vapor compression cycle. These systems are thermodynamically similar to unitary and other common DX systems, and share many of the same components (i.e., compressor, expansion device, heat exchangers). VRF systems transport heat between an outdoor condensing unit and a network of indoor units located near or within the conditioned space through refrigerant piping installed in the building. Attributes that distinguish VRF from other DX system types are multiple indoor units connected to a common outdoor unit (single or combined modules), scalability, variable capacity, distributed control, and simultaneous heating and cooling.

VRF systems are highly engineered, with single or multiple compressors, multiple indoor units (ducted and nonducted types), and oil and refrigerant management and control components. VRF provides flexibility by allowing for many different indoor units (with different capacities and configurations), individual zone control, and the unique ability to offer simultaneous heating and cooling in separate zones on a common refrigerant circuit, and heat recovery from one zone to another. Typical capacities range from 5.3 to 223 kW for outdoor units and from 1.5 to 35 kW for indoor units.

VRF systems operate efficiently at part load due to the compressor's variable capacity control. VRF systems are equipped with at least one variable-speed and/or variable-capacity compressor. Figure 1 illustrates capacity control of a single variable-speed compressor; the compressor varies its speed to operate only at the levels necessary to maintain indoor environments to the specified requirements.

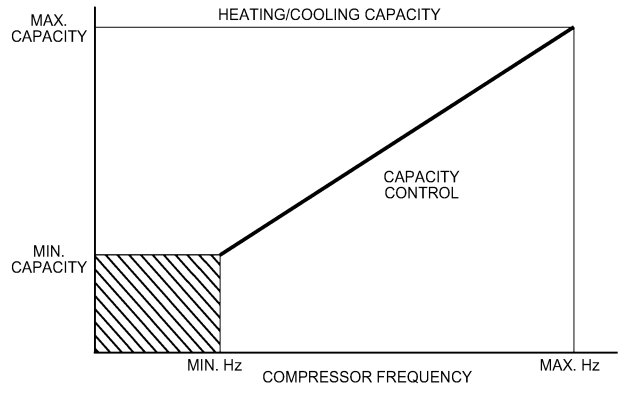


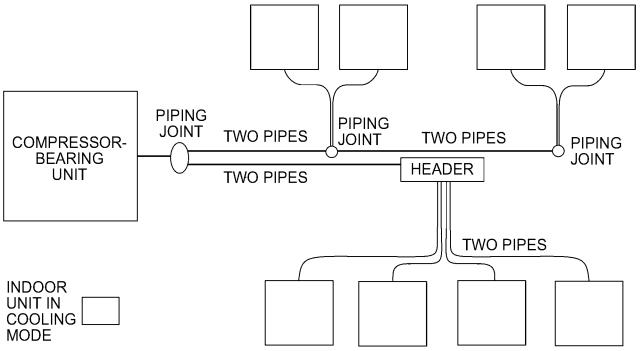
Fig. 1 Compressor Frequency

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.7, Variable Refrigerant Flow (VRF).

System Types

There are three basic types of VRF systems: cooling only (Figure 2), heat pump (Figure 2), and heat recovery (Figures 3 [two-pipe] and 4 [three-pipe]). Heat pumps are air-conditioning systems capable of reversing the direction of the refrigerant flow to provide heating or cooling to the indoor space. All indoor units connected to a heat pump system can use individual control and set points, but they operate in the same mode of either heating or cooling at any given time.

Heat recovery units are heat pump systems that can provide simultaneous cooling and heating. All indoor units connected to a heat recovery system can use individual control and set points, and can operate in heating or cooling mode simultaneously. A heat recovery system transfers thermal energy from one zone to another through the refrigerant lines.



Note: All indoor units operating in either heating or cooling mode.

Fig. 2 Cooling-Only and Heat Pump VRF System

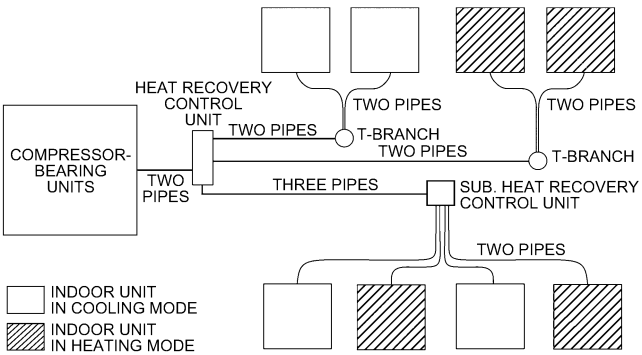


Fig. 3 Two-Pipe Heat Recovery VRF System

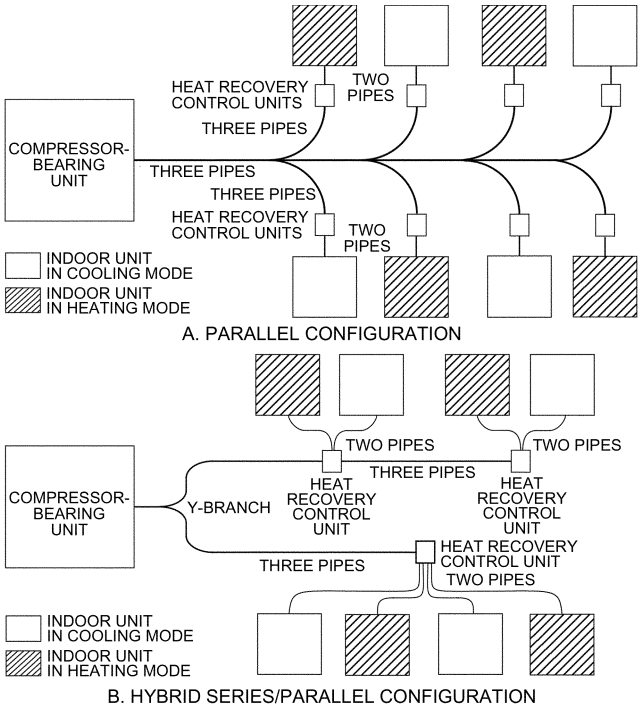


Fig. 4 Three-Pipe Heat Recovery VRF System Examples

Note: Figures 2 to 4 represent various methods of VRF system piping configurations. Please refer to each manufacturer's data for specifics.

A **VRF multisplit system** is a split-system air conditioner or heat pump with a single refrigerant circuit, one or more outdoor units, at least one variable-speed compressor or other compressor combination that can vary system capacity by three or more steps, and multiple indoor fan-coil units that are individually metered and individually controlled by an integrated control device and common communications network. A **VRF heat recovery multisplit system** operates as an air conditioner or heat pump, and also can provide simultaneous heating and cooling operation by transferring recovered energy from the indoor units operating in one mode to other indoor units operating in the other mode. Variable refrigerant flow implies three or more steps of control on common, interconnecting piping.

VRF Applications

VRF systems can be used in various applications, such as

- High- or low-rise offices
- Educational facilities (schools, universities)
- Health care facilities, including clinics and long-term-care nursing homes
- Multifamily residential buildings
- Historical buildings
- Retail stores
- Hospitality centers, restaurants, banquet halls, hotels, and motels
- Data center cooling-only applications
- Cultural facilities, including religious centers

Zoned Comfort

VRF systems achieve temperature control on a zone-by-zone basis primarily by using refrigerant-side control. Indoor units constantly react to changes in the zone's heating/cooling loads, and maintain conditions by controlling target superheat with an electronic expansion valve (EEV) or a linear expansion valve (LEV). The inverter compressors or combination of inverter and constant-speed compressors generally found in VRF systems modulate refrigerant flow, and work in unison with the refrigerant volume required by the indoor units.

Maintaining comfort conditions efficiently can be challenging for HVAC systems during the "shoulder" seasons, usually periods during fall and spring when both heating and cooling maybe required. The ideal changeover from predominantly heating operation to predominantly cooling operation, or vice versa, is often determined by a preset outdoor ambient temperature. With decentralized systems such as heat recovery multisplit systems, buildings can be zoned so that switchover is seamless and comfort is maintained. VRF multisplit systems without heat recovery require greater attention to building load characteristics to achieve proper zoning for comfort.

Indoor Air Quality

Indoor air quality (IAQ) provided by an HVAC system depends on the design zone air change rate, level of ventilation air supplied, and degree of airflow filtration. VRF systems, like traditional unitary systems, must follow associated filtration levels outlined in ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 for ventilation, with filtration provided either centrally, if using a cooling coil, and/or at zone level, if higher levels of filtration are required beyond that provided by the central unit.

To meet ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 requirements, VRF systems are often integrated with a dedicated outdoor air system (DOAS) where ventilation airflow delivery rates remain consistent, regardless of the zone's peak heating or cooling loads or the minimum damper (variable-air-volume terminal unit or central air-handling unit) position. For additional information, see ASHRAE *Guideline* 41, sections 5 and 6.

Annual Operating Efficiency Characteristics

An HVAC system's annual operating efficiency is affected by the building's occupancy profile, orientation, design ventilation air requirements, construction, local outdoor ambient design parameters, air-source versus water-source heat rejection strategies, and other factors. VRF systems operate efficiently at part-load conditions, particularly in heat recovery mode where the system simultaneously provides heating and cooling. For detailed energy estimates, the designer should complete an energy model.

The variable capacity of both the indoor and outdoor units means that the entire system matches the load in any given space. Load matching can also provide benefits such as efficiency at part-load operations and dehumidification. VRF systems feature decentralized individual zoned indoor units, which eliminate the need for large central fans and ductwork.

Local and Remote Monitoring

VRF systems use a manufacturer-specific controls protocol to communicate between outdoor units, indoor units, and available system-specific accessories. Each VRF manufacturer has its own approach to integrating with accessories (e.g., steam or water valves, humidification, dampers, motors) or ancillary equipment, so the designer should consult systems and component engineering and operation manuals for proper control integration.

Controls are integral to the total system design, and the building's application dictates the control package(s) required. VRF systems can function as a stand-alone system using the manufacturer's standard controls, or can integrate with other systems through building automation controls such as BACnet®, LonWorks®, or the manufacturer's method.

Life-Cycle Cost Comparison

An HVAC system's total life-cycle operating costs depend on installed capital costs, annual operating energy costs, routine main-

Table 1 VRF Multisplit System Classifications

Attribute		VRF Multisplit Air Conditioner or Heat Pump	VRF Multisplit Heat Recovery
Refrigerant Circuits		One shared with all indoor units	One shared with all indoor units
Compressors		One or more variable speed or alternative method resulting in three or more steps of capacity	One or more variable speed or alternative method resulting in three or more steps of capacity
Indoor Units	Quantity	More than one indoor unit	More than one indoor unit
	Operation	Individual zones/temperature	Individual zones/temperature
Outdoor Unit(s)[2]	Quantity	One or multiple-manifolded outdoor units with a specific model number	One or multiple-manifolded outdoor units with a specific model number
	Steps of control	Three or more	Three or more
	Mode of operation	Air conditioning, heat pump	Air conditioning, heat pump, heat recovery
	Heat exchanger	One or more circuits of shared refrigerant flow	One or more circuits of shared refrigerant flow
AHRI Classification	Air conditioner (air-to-air)	MSV-A[1]-CB	
	Air conditioner (water-to-air)	MSV-W[1]-CB	
	Heat pump (air-to-air)	HMSV-A[1]-CB	HMSR-A[1]-CB
	Heat pump (water-to-air)	HMSV-W[1]-CB	HMSR-W[1]-CB

Source: Adapted from AHRI *Standard* 1230-2010.
Notes:
[1]"-A" indicates air-cooled condenser and "-W" indicates water-cooled condenser.
[2]For purposes of tested combination definition.

tenance costs, equipment life expectancy, and system replacement costs.

Installed Capital Costs. In new construction, installed capital costs of an air-or water-source VRF system are comparable to those of other engineered HVAC systems. However, the equipment-to-labor ratio costs differ because the primary control components of a VRF system are factory installed or packaged. In an air-source VRF system, the compressor is the main operating component; additional pumps and regulating or control valves are not required. In some climates, air-source VRF systems can satisfy the complete building heating load, avoiding the need for a supplemental or boiler heating system.

Life-Cycle Operating Costs. Life-cycle operating costs for VRF systems are divided into three categories:

- **Annual operating costs** depend on many factors, including building load profiles and heat recovery opportunities.
- **Routine maintenance costs** include remote monitoring tools, which typically enable ongoing VRF system performance reviews and proactive maintenance strategies. Indoor units require regular visual inspection and scheduled air filter replacement. Outdoor units require routine inspection of key components (e.g., compressor, heat exchanger).
- **System replacement costs.** The average life expectancy of air-source VRF systems is 15 to 20 years, and for water-source systems is 20 to 25 years. Equipment life expectancy depends on performing manufacturer-recommended routine maintenance and in some instances is affected by operating hours, environment, placement, etc.

Life-Cycle Analysis Tools. Industry-recognized building energy-simulation tools (including VRF system performance characteristic curves) are proving to be the most accurate strategy for capturing VRF systems' annual performances. Such simulation software programs can also perform a life-cycle analysis.

1. STANDARDS

AHRI has a certification program specifically for VRF multisplit air-conditioning and heat pump equipment. AHRI *Standard* 1230 applies to all VRF multisplit air-conditioning and heat pump/heat recovery equipment with capacities up to 222 kW. It follows AHRI standard rating conditions, and covers all VRF multisplit, matched system air conditioners and heat pumps, regardless of electric power source, refrigeration cycle, or secondary fluid (e.g., air-to-air or water-to-air). In conducting all VRF testing, the following definition is used to configure the systems to be tested. This definition of "tested combination" from AHRI *Standard* 1230 has been a key factor in establishing equivalency of testing with VRF systems and other unitary systems. Table 1 lists VRF multisplit system classifications.

VRF Multisplit Air Conditioners < 19 kW
- Standard rating cooling capacity, kW

VRF Multisplit Air Conditioners ≥ 19 kW
- Standard rating cooling capacity, kW

VRF Multisplit Heat Pumps < 19 kW
- Standard rating cooling capacity, kW
- High-temperature heating standard rating capacity, kW
- Region IV heating seasonal performance factor (HSPF; total heating output of a heat pump, including supplementary electric heat necessary to achieve building heating requirements during normal annual use for heating, divided by total electric power during the same period), minimum design heating requirement, W/W

VRF Multisplit Heat Pumps ≥ 19 kW
- Standard rating cooling capacity, kW
- High-temperature heating standard rating capacity, kW
- High-temperature coefficient of performance (COP); ratio of heating capacity to power input values at any given set of rating conditions; for heating COP, exclude supplementary resistance heat), W/W
- Low-temperature heating standard rating capacity, kW
- Low-temperature coefficient of performance (COP), W/W

VRF Multisplit Heat Recovery Heat Pumps
- Ratings as for VRF multisplit heat pumps
- Simultaneous cooling and heating efficiency (SCHE; ratio of total system capacity for heating and cooling to effective power when operating in heat recovery mode) (50% heating/50% cooling); W/W

VRF Multisplit Heat Pumps Systems with Heat Rejection to Water
- Standard rating cooling capacity, kW
- Heating standard rating capacity, kW
- Heating coefficient of performance (COP), W/W
- Simultaneous cooling and heating efficiency (SCHE) (50% heating/50% cooling; heat recovery models only)

Other testing includes maximum operating conditions, voltage tolerance, low-temperature operation (cooling), insulation effec-

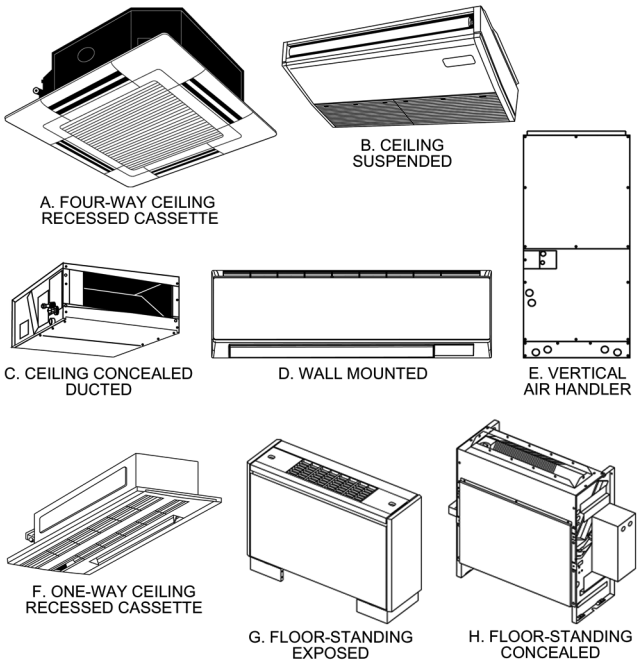


Fig. 5 Common VRF Indoor Unit Types

tiveness (cooling), and condensate disposal (cooling), as outlined in Section 8 of AHRI *Standard* 1230.

2. EQUIPMENT

Air-Source Outdoor and Water-Source Units

Air-source outdoor units and water-source units (sometimes called condensing units, air-to-air units, or air-to-water units) contain circuit boards, heat exchanger(s), and compressor(s). The compressor, the most important component in the VRF system, can be combined with several different types of heat exchange sources.

Most VRF systems use variable-speed scroll or rotary compressors. These compressors are reliable, have very few moving parts, provide continuous compression with little pulsation or vibration, and, through the variable-speed drive, provide modulating linear capacity control. Variable-speed scroll and rotary compressors offer quiet operation and excellent individual full- and part-load efficiencies, and because of precise machining, the vane flanks are sealed with only a thin film of oil. If a single compressor fails in a multiple-outdoor-unit system, peak capacity is lost, but the overall system can still provide partial cooling or heating.

Indoor Unit Types

Indoor units (also called fan-coil units, evaporator units, or air-handling units) are available in many different configurations (Figure 5), including but not limited to the following:

- Wall-mounted
- Recessed-ceiling cassette
- Ceiling-suspended
- Floor-standing
- Ducted

Multiple indoor unit types can be used within a single VRF system.

System Controls

VRF systems have integrated controls in each component to ensure that all system components operate collectively. Depending on the application and design, a VRF system may be able to operate with many levels of controls (Figure 6). Each indoor unit may be managed by a local controller, or multiple indoor units serving the same zone can be operated by the same controller. Each manufacturer offers centralized controllers, which allow the user to monitor and control VRF systems and ancillary equipment from a single location or through the Internet. Manufacturers also offer open protocol communication gateways for higher-level monitoring.

System Expansion or Reconfiguration

The modular nature of VRF systems lends itself to easy system expansion or reconfiguration as building needs change. During design, the designer and client can discuss any possible future or changing needs in the building envelope.

VRF air-source outdoor units and water-source units can be sized based on future building requirements according to manufacturers' recommendations to anticipate supplementary indoor units without affecting the performance of currently installed indoor units or overall system performance. This allows for VRF systems to accommodate the heating and cooling needs of the building as each section of the building is commissioned.

When a building or zone is repurposed, indoor units may be added, relocated, or exchanged with minimal disruption. Indoor units may be relocated or changed out for different types or capacities in a given space as occupancy needs change, as long as the overall system capacity capabilities are maintained. This can be accomplished by simply reconfiguring indoor unit refrigerant piping, electrical wiring, control wiring, and drain piping. Note, however, that in some applications, piping sizes may change as capacity sizes change. Obtain manufacturer recommendations on piping design and diversity parameters before performing any type of indoor unit installation or relocation.

3. VRF SYSTEM OPERATION

A thorough understanding of how VRF heat pump units operate and how the different components function individually (and as part of the system) is important for successfully designing and applying VRF systems. Designers should consider many operation factors before proposing VRF heat pump systems for a building project:

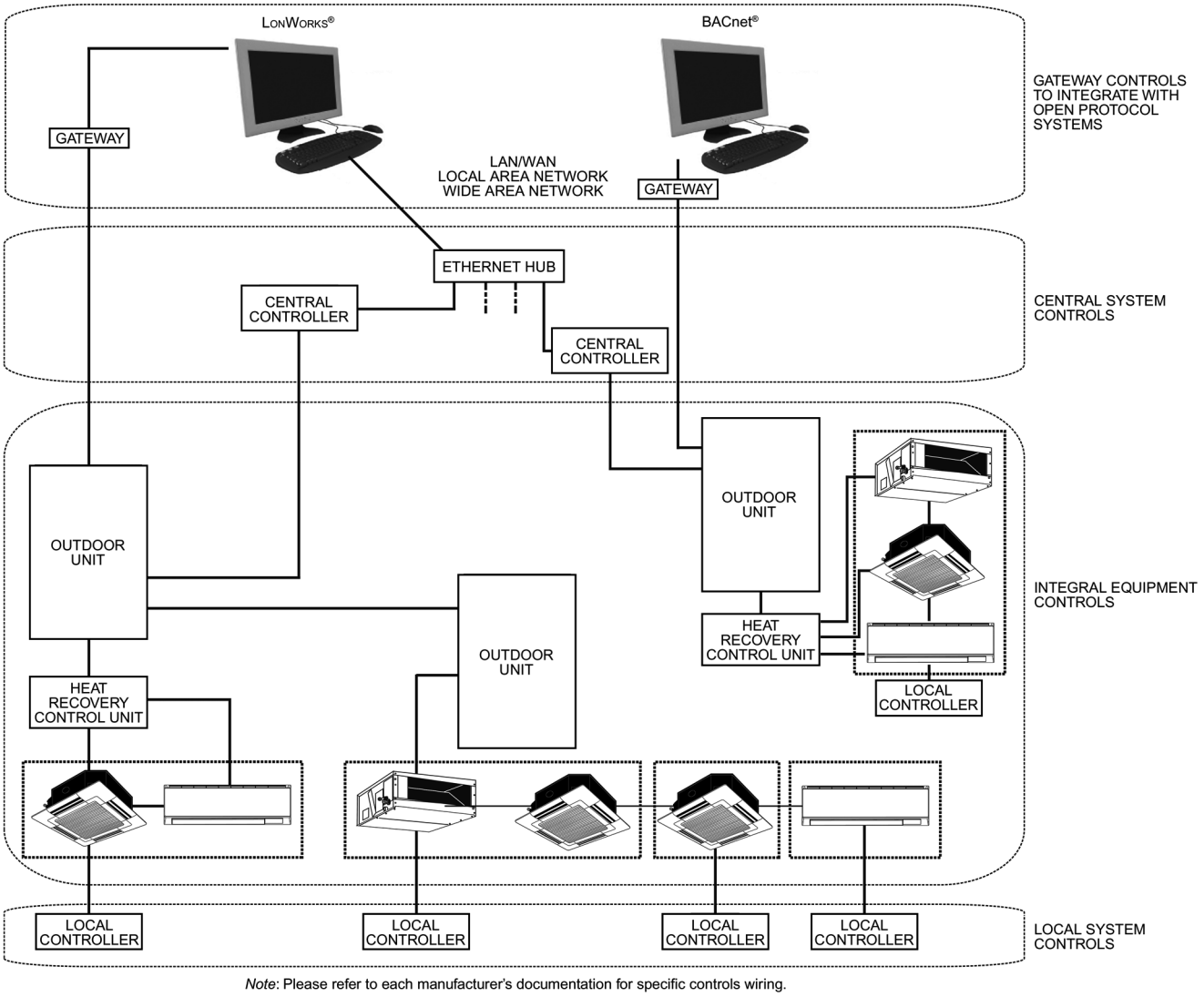
- Load management
- Cooling operation
- Heating operation
- Saturation temperature reset
- Heat recovery operation
- Defrost operation
- Oil recovery management
- Humidity control

Load Management

At the zone level, a VRF heat pump system's indoor units perform load management (sometimes called capacity control) through an EEV or LEV. At the system level, the outdoor unit conducts load management through the inverter-driven variable-speed compressor(s), or an alternative combination for varying capacity and variable-speed air-source outdoor unit fans.

For cooling operation, the compressor is controlled through monitoring the target evaporating temperature or target superheat. For heating operation, the compressor is controlled through monitoring the target condensing temperature or target subcooling (Figure 7).

These values are then used to control the VRF system's compressor, fan motor, and EEV/LEV to ensure stable target temperature control, regardless of varying loads and environmental conditions (Table 2).



Note: Please refer to each manufacturer's documentation for specific controls wiring.

Fig. 6 Controls System Example

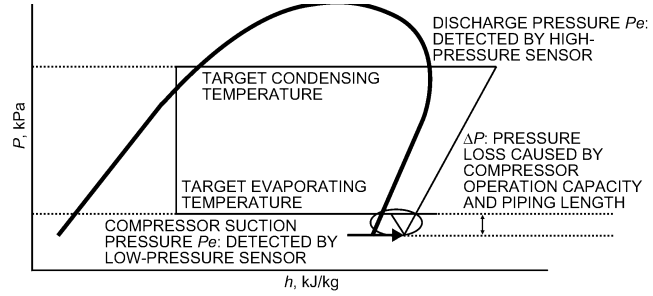


Fig. 7 Typical VRF Enthalpy-Pressure Chart

Table 2 Examples of Typical Refrigerant Values

Refrigerant	Typical Condensing Temperature/High Pressure	Typical Evaporating Temperature/High Pressure
R-22	46°C, 1900 kPa	5.5°C, 700 kPa
R-407C	48°C, 2000 kPa	7.5°C, 680 kPa
R-410A	46°C, 2900 kPa	6.0°C, 1060 kPa

Note: Typical values may vary depending on the refrigerant manufacturer.

Cooling Operation

The indoor units of a VRF system are designed to operate at variable cooling capacities to match the load in the given zone. In cooling mode, the indoor unit's EEVs or LEVs are controlled to maintain a target superheat value or evaporator temperature. Superheat is determined by calculating the temperature difference between the indoor unit vapor pipe thermistor and liquid refrigerant pipe thermistor. When the difference between set point and zone temperature decreases, the expansion valve throttles (and vice versa), maintaining the target superheat. The total system capacity is influenced by the number of indoor units operating in cooling mode, airflow rates, zone load, and indoor and outdoor ambient conditions.

The air-source outdoor units and water-source units operate as a variable condenser controlled to maintain a preset differential between the sink (ambient air or water) temperature and condensing temperature. Expansion takes place independently at each indoor unit. As the load for each individual indoor unit changes, the EEV/LEV modulates to control the target superheat and/or evaporator

temperature. The compressor(s) adjust to match the total system load by varying the refrigerant flow as demanded by the indoor units.

Indoor unit sizing should be guided by calculated load, but the units' variable capacity allows for design flexibility, and capacity-to-load matching is less critical than for single capacity systems.

Heating Operation

In heating mode, the EEV or LEV of the indoor unit is controlled to maintain target subcooling or coil temperature. Subcooling is determined by calculating the temperature difference between the system condensing temperature and the indoor unit's liquid pipe thermistor. When the difference between the set point and zone temperature decreases, the expansion valve throttles (and vice versa), maintaining the target subcooling. As with cooling mode, the total system capacity is influenced by the number of indoor units operating in cooling mode, airflow rates, zone load, and indoor and outdoor ambient conditions

The coil in the air-source outdoor unit or water-source unit is now acting as the evaporator, and the EEV or LEV opens and closes according to the superheat value detected in the suction pipe, operating as necessary to maintain the target superheat value. As the load at each individual indoor unit changes, the compressor(s) adjust to vary refrigerant flow to match the total system load.

Saturation Temperature Reset

Standard operation of the VRF system's compressor(s) consists of maintaining either a target evaporating saturation temperature or a target condensing temperature; the target temperatures are typically fixed, as shown in Table 2. Under this control, maintaining system capacity is the priority.

Some VRF systems incorporate configurable control logic to allow the target saturation temperatures to float based on operating conditions (e.g., ambient temperature and indoor unit load) to balance between operating efficiency and capacity. During cooling, as load on the system drops, the target evaporating temperature is reset upward to reduce lift on the compressor and improve energy efficiency. As system load increases, the target evaporating temperature is reset downward to increase system capacity and maintain indoor comfort levels.

When heating, the target condensing temperature can be reset lower through the control logic during low-load conditions to reduce compressor lift and improve efficiency. As system load increases, the target condensing temperature is reset upward to increase system capacity and maintain indoor comfort levels.

Because response time and operation are affected, consult the manufacturer for specific operation parameters to determine which control strategy is best for design condition and application.

Heat Recovery Operation

Heat recovery systems can transfer energy from one zone to another. The amount of energy transferred depends on the operation mode of the individual indoor units. The outdoor unit operates in cooling or heating as determined by the greater demand of the indoor units. Heat recovery operation can be common in shoulder seasons, and is applicable in all seasons if a building has different zone load profiles such as interior room loads versus exterior room loads. Heat recovery operation can also be applied to buildings with an east/west or north/south orientation, and when occupancy profiles are based on time of day.

Manufacturers offer two design approaches to VRF heat recovery operation: two-pipe and three-pipe systems.

Two-Pipe Systems. Two-pipe VRF heat recovery systems include a heat recovery control unit (sometimes called a branch controller, branch box, or heat recovery unit) that acts as an intermediate heat exchanger between the indoor units and the outdoor unit(s).

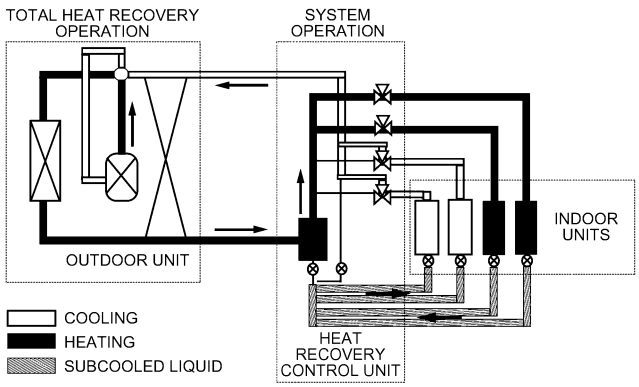


Fig. 8 Two-Pipe VRF Heat Recovery System Operation

This unit houses a series of diverting valves and gas/liquid separators to move high- or low-pressure refrigerant between the indoor units, minimizing the load transferred directly to the outdoor unit (Figure 8).

Two-pipe VRF heat recovery systems are in total or balanced heat recovery mode when the peak zone heating and cooling loads are equal. During balanced heat recovery mode, hot refrigerant gas is delivered from the outdoor unit compressor to the heat recovery control unit, where it is then distributed to the indoor units in the zones that require heating.

Any subcooled refrigerant from the indoor units in heating mode is delivered back to the heat recovery control unit, where it is redistributed to the indoor units in cooling mode. Refrigerant leaving the indoor units in cooling mode is in a low-pressure vapor state, completing the state of equilibrium in the refrigeration cycle. This low-pressure vapor is delivered to the heat recovery control unit before returning to the outdoor unit compressor, where it is compressed to high-pressure gas by adding the heat of compression to the process. The cycle repeats itself in the preceding manner. If the system is not completely balanced between heating and cooling loads, the heat exchanger in the outdoor unit is not bypassed. Heat energy is partially absorbed or rejected, depending on the balance between heating and cooling loads.

Three-Pipe Systems. Three-pipe VRF systems include one high-pressure vapor pipe, one low-pressure vapor pipe, and one liquid pipe between the outdoor unit and the heat recovery control unit(s). The heat recovery control unit controls the direction of refrigerant flow through the indoor units. In heating mode, the high-pressure vapor pipe opens and the low-pressure vapor pipe closes, allowing refrigerant to flow through the high-pressure vapor pipe and into the indoor unit, where it condenses, turning the indoor unit into a zoned condenser. In cooling mode, the high-pressure vapor pipe closes and the low-pressure vapor pipe opens, allowing refrigerant to flow through the liquid pipe into the indoor unit, where it evaporates, turning the indoor unit into an evaporator.

A three-pipe VRF system's heat recovery control units can have either single or multiple ports, and each port can provide heating or cooling independently of other ports (Figure 9). One or more indoor units can connect to each port on the heat recovery unit, but if multiple indoor units are connected to a single port, they will operate in the same mode. Numbers and capacity of indoor units connected must follow manufacturer's recommendation.

Multilayer Heat Recovery in Water-Source VRF Systems. Water-source VRF systems offer an opportunity for two levels of heat recovery, because heat energy can be exchanged between zones at the refrigerant level as well as between systems through the water loop (Figure 10).

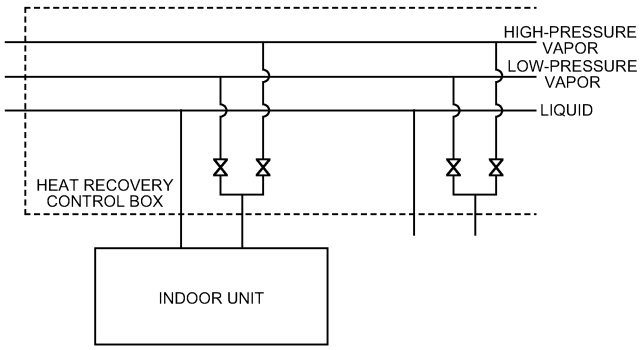


Fig. 9 Three-Pipe Heat Recovery System Operation

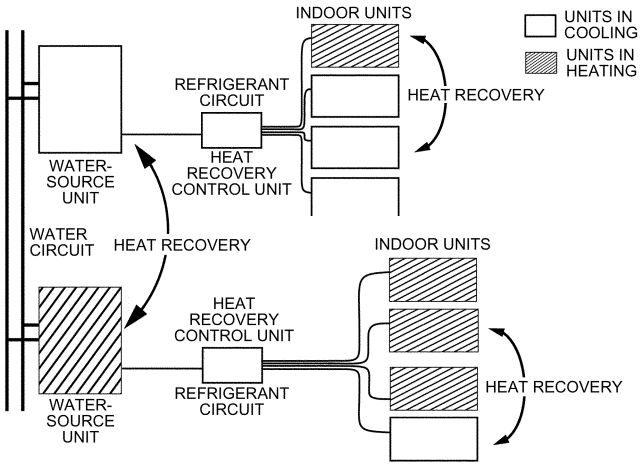


Fig. 10 Multilayer Heat Recovery Operation

Defrost Operation

As with all air-source heat pump systems, VRF outdoor unit heat exchanger coils can accumulate frost during heating operation under some temperature and humidity conditions. Defrost-cycle operation is included to melt accumulating frost, but it differs with each manufacturer.

Sometimes defrost initiates after a fixed time or variable minimum time, based on a temperature difference sensed between ambient and refrigerant. Some systems sense frost build-up through a temperature reduction in the low-pressure vapor refrigerant line, and/or a low temperature at the outdoor unit's heat exchanger coils. Heating operation stops, and the system reverses refrigerant flow, making the outdoor unit coil a condenser to melt accumulating frost. Indoor units switch off for the duration of defrost operation to avoid unwanted cooling of the conditioned space. Alternatively, an indoor unit can maintain space temperature through an output signal to a supplemental heater (duct or perimeter), as controlled from a room-based thermistor.

Manufacturers may use a partial defrost approach, which uses a split-coil configuration in the outdoor unit(s), and defrost only half the coil at a time while still providing approximately 30 to 40% of its heating capacity. If a system has multiple outdoor units piped together to make a single system, manufacturers may choose to defrost each outdoor unit separately, or defrost all the outdoor units on a single system together to decrease overall system defrost time or ensure clearing the coil of ice most effectively. A manufacturer may also use logic that allows equipment to run either a partial defrost in conditions where it is easier to defrost the coil or when it does not adversely affect efficiency, or full defrost to ensure the coil is completely free of ice when it is more difficult to defrost the coil to maintain capacity.

During defrost operation, outdoor units will generate condensate. Inadequate condensate management may lead to slip/fall hazards. Air-source VRF outdoor units can be installed indoors with manufacturer-specific duct and ambient temperature requirements. Even in applications where designers choose to locate the outdoor units indoors, adequate condensate disposal methods and condensate freeze protection must be factored into the design.

Oil Recovery Management

During normal operation, oil may migrate out of the compressor, so manufacturers may include an oil separator for each compressor in the outdoor unit(s). The oil separator uses compressor discharge velocity to spin refrigerant out to the separator's shell, where oil collects on the walls, then drains by gravity to the bottom and back to the compressor's oil sump.

Oil separators collect most of the oil; however, a small amount of oil remains entrained in the refrigerant leaving the separator, and often collects in the piping system and indoor units. To reclaim oil that settles in the system and away from the sump, the controls open the EEV or LEV in all indoor units (even if they are not in operation) after a set period of compressor operation. The compressor switches to a predetermined speed or setting to ensure oil in the system flushes back to the compressor sump. The oil recovery cycle generally engages after the compressor has been operating for a predetermined number of hours, and may factor in operational capacity to adjust the frequency of the cycle, or use an oil level sensor. Oil recovery typically lasts from 3 to 6 min and may affect operational mode, as defined by the manufacturer.

Humidity Control

Zone comfort and associated indoor unit output are controlled based on a dry-bulb temperature set point in the space or at a central location. The sensible-to-total-cooling ratio is typically in the 70 to 80% range, depending on airflow across the unit and ambient air or condenser water temperatures. The rated capacities of the installed indoor units typically match the peak total heating or cooling load for the specific zone's total, sensible, and latent elements. Indoor unit output follows the load profile curve for that specific zone. The sensible-to-latent-load ratio changes with indoor and outdoor ambient conditions in most cooling applications.

Some indoor units include a dry mode that could provide dehumidification once zone temperatures rise above a dew-point temperature threshold. In dry mode, the indoor unit operates at a low fan speed to keep the coil cold, and at sufficient capacity to remove moisture from the air without significantly lowering room temperature. If the zone temperature drops below a designated set point (depending on individual manufacturer's specifications), the indoor unit may shut off.

If a **dedicated outdoor air system (DOAS)** is applied to a VRF system, the lower off-coil temperatures at the DOAS allow the DOAS to manage a significant proportion of the outdoor air's latent cooling load. This lets the indoor units of the VRF system manage the majority of sensible and latent cooling loads of the indoor air.

In winter heating cycles where humidification is required to maintain zone comfort, a supplemental humidification unit can be used through the ventilation air system. An energy recovery ventilator (ERV), as opposed to a heat recovery wheel or core ventilator, as part of the ventilation air system can help reduce latent loads during cooling mode. In winter heating mode, cool, dry outdoor supply air is partially humidified by moist exhaust air. In summer cooling mode, moisture from outdoor supply air is transferred to the

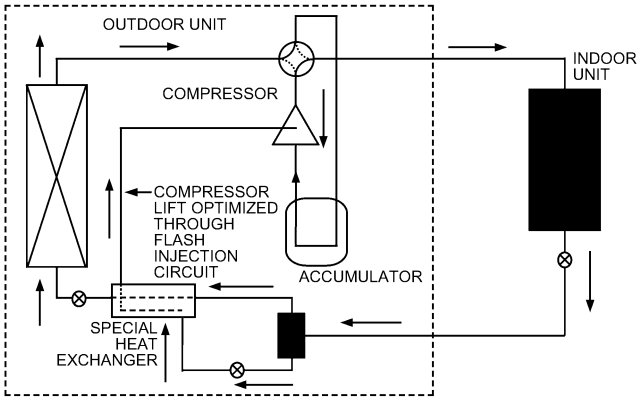


Fig. 11 Flash Injection Schematic

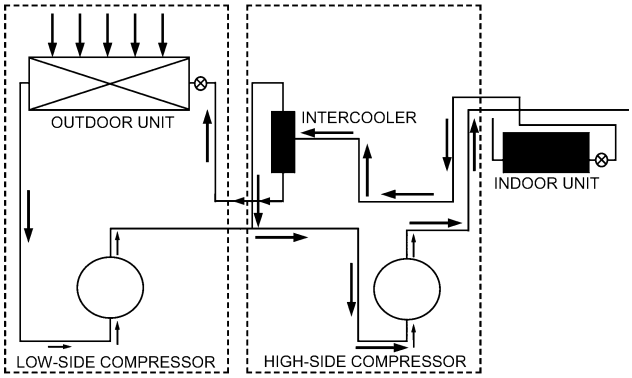


Fig. 12 Staged Compression Cycle Schematic

dry exhaust air, thus reducing the latent load on the VRF indoor units.

High-Heating-Performance Air-Source VRF Units

To deliver higher heating performance of air-source VRF systems in low-ambient-temperature conditions, manufacturers have developed refrigeration cycles so that 100% nominal heating performance can be maintained as low as –15°C ambient, and with approximately 80% heating output at –25°C. Strategies to achieve these heating performance levels include flash injection and a staged compression cycle. In some climates, supplemental heating may still be required to meet peak heating loads for the zone.

Flash Injection. Some air-source VRF systems include flash injection technology on a single-compressor refrigeration circuit to offer increased heating output at lower ambient temperatures. Such systems offer nominal heating output at ambient temperatures as low as –18°C. The flash gas flow is modulated to an intermediate point in the compression process based on the difference between the required heating output and external ambient conditions. Compressor speed is optimized based on the circuit load (Figure 11).

Staged Compression Cycle. An alternative approach to achieving higher-temperature outputs at lower ambient conditions is to use compound compression with intermediate economizers (Figure 12).

4. MODELING CONSIDERATIONS

Computer-based, whole-building energy performance modeling and simulation is an effective method to predict and evaluate the energy and cost benefits of various building technologies. Energy performance modeling is also an important tool for building energy labeling and certification programs and for developing model energy codes. A comprehensive review of energy estimating and modeling methods is provided in Chapter 19 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Additional guidance may also be found in ASHRAE *Guideline* 41.

VRF equipment has recently been added to the most commonly used building energy modeling programs, allowing engineers and architects to compare the energy efficiency and life-cycle costs of VRF to other systems in various climate zones. Modeling considerations specific to VRF equipment include

- Matching the sizing ratio of the total indoor terminal unit rated capacity and the total outdoor unit rated capacity (i.e., connected capacity) to manufacturer specifications
- Part-load performance of the heat pump's variable-speed compressor
- Losses associated with the refrigerant piping lengths
- Heat recovery (simultaneous cooling and heating) in some energy models

5. DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

When designing a project, many factors should be considered for VRF systems, including

- New construction or retrofit applications
- Construction schedule
- Building orientation and layout
- Building occupancy characteristics (including future zoning)
- Peak heating and cooling load profiles (including occurrence)
- Integration of renewable energy sources
- Zone-specific design considerations, such as acoustic performance levels
- Building space allocation for mechanical equipment
- Opportunities for capturing waste heat in the mechanical system
- Application-specific ventilation air requirements
- Life-cycle performance and green-building certification expectations
- Local design weather conditions
- Local/remote control/monitoring requirements
- Opportunities for simultaneous heating and cooling for comfort conditioning

After all factors are analyzed, the engineer may choose from a range of VRF system types.

Water-Source VRF Systems

Water-source VRF systems can be applied in the same design scenarios as air-source systems. They can also be used in a range of building application types but must be integrated with geothermal heat sinks or boiler/cooling tower systems. If applied to year-round cooling applications, water-source VRF systems allow optimizing water-loop temperatures, along with compressor power input in correspondence with ambient wet bulb. The need for supplemental boiler/heating systems depends on the design.

Depending on the application design parameters, water-loop systems offer performance advantages over air-source systems, such as

- High annual system COP levels (depending on system)
- Consistent performance because of smaller fluctuations in loop temperature
- Low- or high-ambient heating or cooling
- No defrost cycles
- Multilayer heat recovery

Nominal capacities for water-source systems are typically based on an entering water temperature of 21°C for heating, and 29°C for cooling. For appropriate system operation during standard heating and cooling modes, the entering water temperature can range from 10 to 45°C but can operate with loop fluid temperatures as low as

–10°C (e.g., in geothermal applications). Each manufacturer has its own specific performance characteristics.

The rated heated capacity of a water-source VRF system is not directly affected by the external ambient temperature. The condenser water-loop heat source, which can be a boiler or ground/well, can be sized to minimize or eliminate a reduction in heating capacity due to low ambient temperatures. The condenser water loop must be maintained at a predetermined temperature set point to ensure nominal heating output.

Air-Source VRF Systems

Air-source VRF systems have been applied in many design conditions, including

- External ambient cooling design applications between 46 and –29°C
- High-sensible-heat-ratio cooling applications
- External ambient heating-dominant applications lower than –25°C

Low External Ambient Heating-Dominant Applications

Heating capacities of air-source VRF outdoor units are derated as ambient temperature decreases, down to approximately 60% heating capacity at –20°C. There are three strategies for decreasing the effect of lower ambient temperatures on VRF systems during the heating operation:

- Sizing air-source VRF units to meet the design heating load
- Integration with supplemental heating sources
- Locating the air-source unit in a temperate or controlled ambient environment (e.g., equipment room, parking garage)

Integration with Supplemental Heating Sources

In some climates, supplemental heating may still be required to meet peak heating loads for the zone. VRF systems can be integrated with supplemental perimeter or duct-mounted electric, gas-fired, or hot-water-based heating systems. Supplemental heating components can be enabled based on a preset ambient temperature measured at the outdoor unit, and/or on a zone-by-zone basis using the indoor unit and a preset dead band between design space temperature and actual space temperature. If the application calls only for zone-by-zone activation, size the supplemental heating component based on the difference between the rated mechanical heating capacity at design conditions and peak design zone heat load. In some instances, full supplemental heating may need to be factored into the design.

Outdoor Air Economizer

The model building energy codes [ASHRAE/IES *Standard* 90.1 and the *International Energy Conservation Code*® (IECC®) (ICC 2015)] each have a prescriptive requirement for the use of air-side economizers, which use outdoor air instead of mechanical cooling to cool the indoor space. Air-side economizers are not required by the codes in every application. Climate zones 1a and 1b are exempt from this requirement, and in ASHRAE/IES *Standard* 90.1, for the remaining climate zones, indoor units (sometimes called fan-coil units, evaporator units, or air-handling units) with a cooling capacity under 15.8 kW are exempt. Both model codes also provide exceptions related to increased energy efficiency for equipment in certain climate zones. Some state energy codes provide an exemption to the economizer requirement for VRF systems with heat recovery (simultaneous cooling and heating).

Table 3 Minimum Fan-Cooling Unit Size Requiring Economizer for Comfort Cooling

Climate Zone	Cooling Capacity Requiring Economizer
1a, 1b	No economizer requirement
2a, 2b, 3a, 4a, 5a, 6a	≥16 kW
3b, 3c, 4b, 4c, 5b, 6b, 7, 8	

Source: ASHRAE/IES *Standard* 90.1-2013 Table 6.5.1-1.

Generating Radiant Heating/Cooling and Domestic Hot Water

VRF systems can generate chilled or hot water for space cooling or heating purposes, or domestic hot water for other applications. In such applications, a refrigerant/water indoor heat exchange module with integrated controls is included in the system format. VRF manufacturers use different strategies to achieve each capability.

In some zones, indoor units could be replaced by a radiant floor or cooling/heating panel that receives water from a refrigerant-to-water heat exchanger. Adopting a similar strategy, the VRF system can generate domestic hot water with leaving water temperatures up to 71°C by using a heat exchanger with a booster refrigeration cycle. The refrigerant-to-water heat exchanger could also be used for preheating purposes in some applications. The refrigerant-to-water heat exchanger is selected based on design peak cooling/heating capacity, cooling/heating leaving water temperature, water-side design temperature difference, and water flow rates.

6. VRF SYSTEM DESIGN EXAMPLE

Performing a Load-Profile Analysis

The complete specification of a VRF system requires careful planning at the design stage, and a detailed analysis of project needs and the building's annual cooling and heating load profiles are required before equipment is selected and sized.

For example, an engineer is designing an HVAC system for a 465 m^2, single-story office commercial building in Nashville, Tennessee, with an east/west layout orientation. Nashville has a local design ambient condition of 34°C db for summer and –9°C db for winter. For the building's cooling and heating load profile, see Table 4.

System Type Selection, Zoning, and Potential for Heat Recovery

VRF system selection, whether heat pump versus heat recovery or air-source versus water-source, is driven by many factors, most notably the best balance between operating costs and capital costs per unit area. A complete energy analysis of the building is necessary to evaluate which system type is most appropriate for the application.

After studying the peak load profile, the designer could divide the building into three main zones with similar occupancy profiles, with each zone served by a dedicated heat pump system. For the

Table 4 Peak Load Profile

Zone	Cooling at 3 PM in August, kW	Cooling at 11 AM in August, kW	Heating at 8 AM in January, kW	Indoor Unit Capacity, kW
Office 1	4.3	2.6	4.5	4.4
Office 2	3.1	1.8	2.9	3.5
Office 3	3.1	1.8	2.9	3.5
Office 4	3.8	2.3	3.3	4.4
Reception	3.9	6.6	5.5	7.0
Office 5	1.4	2.3	2.2	2.3
Corridor	0.4	0.6	0.3	N/A
Electrical Room	7.6	8.2	N/A	10.6
Total Peak	**27.6**	**26.2**	**21.6**	—

electrical room, the dedicated system (either water-source or low-ambient air-source) would operate in cooling mode all year.

- West zone: Offices 1, 2, 3, and 4
- East zone: Reception, Office 5, and Corridor
- Cooling-only zone: Electrical room

There is potential, however, for heat recovery operation in this building. Waste heat from the cooling-only electrical room zone can be recovered and redistributed to other zones when those zones are in heating mode. The building's east/west orientation indicates that, during the April/May and September/October shoulder seasons, some zones may need heating while others may need cooling. Changing peak occupancy levels may also offer opportunities for heat recovery. When in simultaneous heating and cooling, waste energy from the reception area can be applied to other areas of the building if those areas require heat during shoulder seasons (Figure 13). If necessary, waste heat from the cooling-only electrical room zone could also be used to generate or preheat domestic hot water for the building. These factors offer a short payback period on any capital premium that the air-source heat recovery system has over the air-source heat pump system. Building analysis reveals that a VRF heat recovery system would be appropriate for this application.

Accurately Sizing Air-Source Outdoor and Indoor Units

Many factors must be considered before sizing the outdoor and indoor units. Outdoor unit size is based on the actual peak cooling or heating load, whichever is higher. Most VRF manufacturers have selection software that provides detailed information, taking into account correction factors for each specific operation to ensure proper design and sizing of system components. The following examples are provided to show how the software addresses adjustments to system capacity based on factors such as line lengths, ambient temperatures, and connected capacities of indoor units.

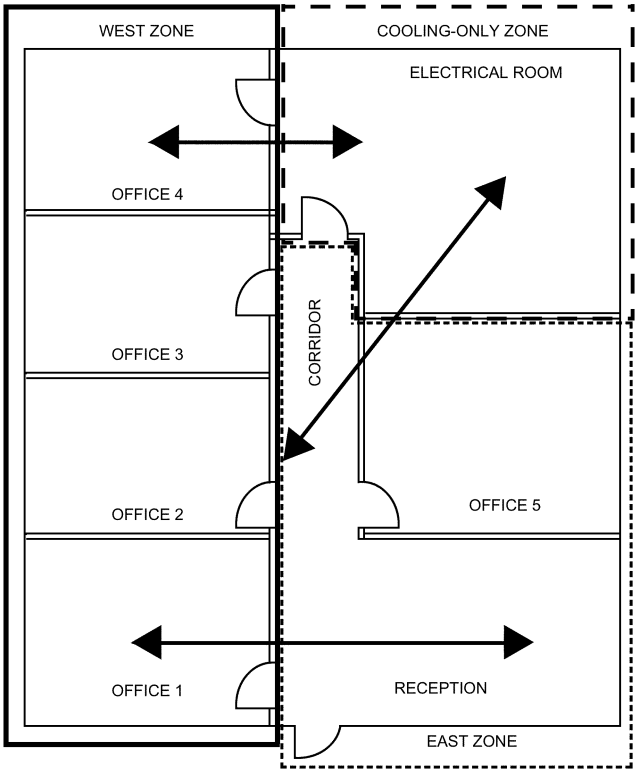


Fig. 13 Example System Zoning

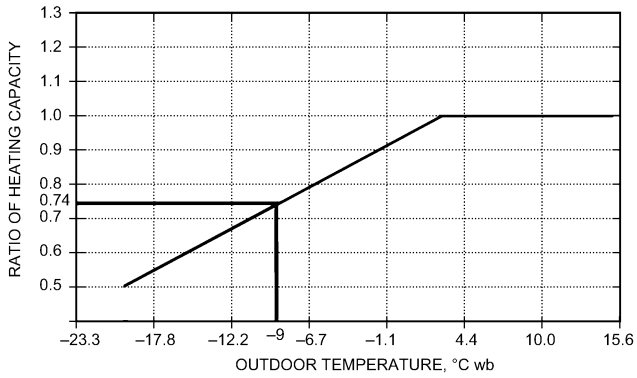
In the example, the peak cooling load is approximately 27.6 kW, occurring at 3 PM in August; the peak heating load is 21.6 kW, occurring at 8 AM in January. The outdoor unit should be sized based on the peak cooling load of 27.6 kW; thus, one 28 kW outdoor unit with 28 kW for cooling and 31.7 kW for heating should be chosen.

The effect of local ambient conditions on system performance also should be considered. As with all heat pump systems, the system may have reduced heating output at lower ambient conditions, or may operate in defrost more often than is desired. Designers should include the derating factor to verify that the chosen system will provide the required capacity at the necessary design temperatures. For the example, at the winter ambient design temperature of –9°C, a 28 kW air-cooled outdoor unit's heating output is derated by a factor of 0.74 (Figure 14).

Thus, 0.74 × 31.7 = 23.5 kW, which fulfills the peak heating load of the building. Additionally, the VRF system's heating output can be derated based on the maximum refrigerant piping length from the outdoor unit to the farthest indoor unit. This capacity correction factor reflects the compressor energy expended when moving refrigerant through the VRF system. In the example, the maximum refrigerant piping length is 37 m, so the heating capacity correction factor is 0.98 (Figure 15).

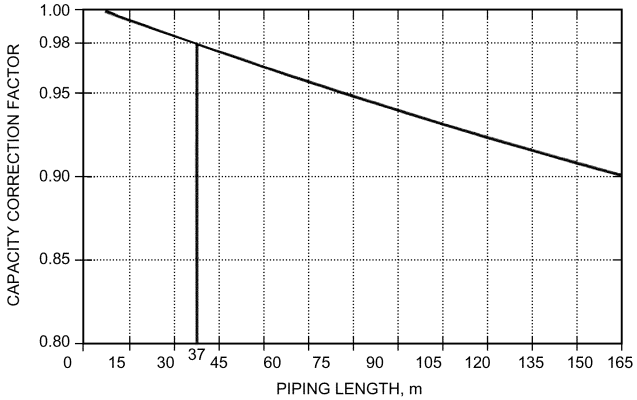
Design winter ambient = –9°C, Derate factor = 0.74
Refrigerant piping length correction factor at 37 m = 0.98
Corrected heating capacity = 31.7 × 0.74 × 0.98 = 23 kW

A similar process should be used when confirming the proposed system's cooling performance. The rated condition temperature for outdoor unit cooling capacity is 35°C. In this example, the summer



Note: Representative data. Not specific for each manufacturer.

Fig. 14 Heating Output Derating Chart



Note: Representative data. Not specific for each manufacturer.

Fig. 15 Maximum Refrigerant Piping Length Capacity Correction Factor

ambient design temperature is 34.4°C; therefore, derating is not required (Figure 16).

The system must be derated for refrigerant piping length. In the example, the maximum refrigerant piping length is 37 m, and, as in the heating calculations, the cooling capacity correction factor is 0.98 (see Figure 15).

Design summer ambient = 34.4°C db, Derate factor = 1.00
Refrigerant piping length correction factor at 37 m = 0.98
Corrected cooling capacity = 28.2 × 0.98 = 27.6 kW

Designers also must verify that the connected nominal capacity of the indoor units is within the operating parameters of the selected system. VRF heat pump systems can operate with a connected nominal capacity of up to 130% of the outdoor unit nominal capacity. General industry design practices are to design systems with up to 130% nominal capacity. Connected capacities above 130% are not typical. If the designer desires to exceed 130% connected capacity, caution must be used. During the design phase, the designer must consult with the manufacturer to validate that the design is acceptable. VRF heat recovery systems can operate with a connected nominal capacity of up to 150%, or, for some special applications, up to 200% of the outdoor unit nominal capacity. Connected capacity ratios depend on the system's ability to meet peak cooling and heating loads; connected capacity ratio is calculated by indoor unit connected nominal capacity divided by outdoor unit nominal capacity.

For the example, the total indoor unit connected capacity is 35.7 kW; the nominal outdoor unit capacity is 28 kW: 35.7 kW/28 kW = 128%.

The 128% is within the connected capacity allowed for VRF heat recovery systems.

Selecting Indoor Units

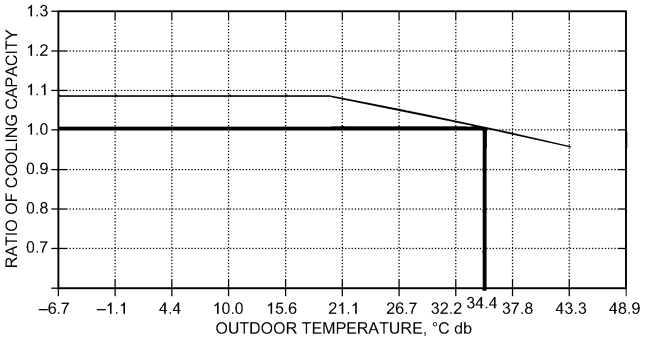
Indoor units are selected for each zone based on style and additional design considerations, such as the following:

- Peak cooling and heating capacities
- Ratio of sensible to latent cooling load
- Air change rate
- Sound performance criteria
- Terminal unit air-side distribution and location restrictions
- Ventilation air strategy (following ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 criteria)
- Integration with supplemental heating components, if any

For the example, the designer may include different indoor unit styles to satisfy project requirements (Figure 17). In the cooling-only zone (the electrical room), the sensible-to-latent cooling ratio is high; the indoor unit rating must be selected to match the requirements for the space.

Office 1 requires other design considerations:

Peak cooling load = 4.3 kW
Peak heating load = 4.5 kW



Note: Representative data. Not specific for each manufacturer.

Fig. 16 Cooling Output Derating Chart

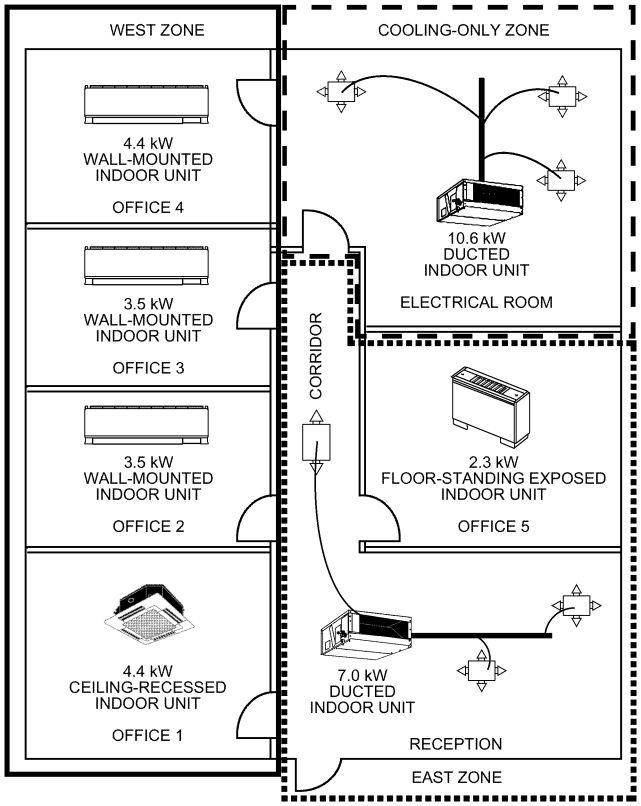


Fig. 17 Indoor Unit Layout

Air change rate = 4 ach
Sound performance criteria = NC 35
Ventilation supply = 40 L/s (see the Ventilation Air Strategy section)

The designer could choose a ducted indoor unit with

Nominal cooling output of 4.4 kW
Nominal heating output of 5.0 kW
Sound performance rating of NC 30
Nominal airflow rate of 225 to 315 L/s

Ventilation Air Strategy

Designers can select many different types of ventilation equipment to complement a VRF system. There are three main strategies: direct, integrated, and decoupled. Selection depends on climate, application, and equipment type.

Direct Method

Outdoor air is mixed with return air and conditioned by the VRF indoor unit. The mixed air temperature from the ventilation system should have sufficient mixing factored in to enable effective coil performance. Consult the manufacturer for guidance on entering coil limitations. Consider the effect of mixed air conditions when the VRF indoor unit is not actively heating or cooling.

- Used for applications in mild to moderate climates, and/or situations requiring small amounts of outdoor air.
- Reduces system complexity and initial equipment costs.
- Climate or ventilation volume requirements must be treated with caution where outdoor air could increase humidity levels to an unacceptable level in the space. For example, a high volume of outdoor air could result in high humidity levels in a conference room during unoccupied periods when the cooling load is reduced. Note that, to ensure minimum ventilation requirements, the VRF indoor unit fan must run at design fan speed at all times.

Integrated Method

Outdoor air is pretreated by mechanical means such as a 100% outdoor air unit, a DOAS, a heat recovery ventilator (HRV), or an energy recovery ventilator (ERV) before being supplied to the VRF indoor unit through the return air or supply ductwork.

- Allows the dedicated ventilation system to handle all or part of the outdoor air load. The VRF indoor unit is sized for the internal space load, and possibly part of the outdoor air load.
- Used for applications in moderate to extreme climates.
- VRF indoor unit provides final tempering of the mixed airstream and should be sized accordingly.
- Allows reduced overall VRF equipment capacity and increased application flexibility.
- Maintains ventilation air quantity by indoor unit fan operation.

Decoupled Method

Ventilation air is supplied directly to the conditioned space. Both a decoupled dedicated ventilation system, such as a DOAS, and a VRF system can be installed. The function of the VRF system is to maintain comfort in the conditioned space.

- Allows the dedicated ventilation system to handle the entire outdoor air load. The VRF system is sized only for the internal space load.
- Used for applications in any type of climate, and situations requiring any amount of outdoor air.
- Can introduce large amounts of outdoor air as needed. The VRF indoor unit fan can be programmed to cycle on/off based on heating and cooling requirements, regardless of ventilation demands, thus increasing system efficiency.
- Allows reduced VRF equipment capacity and increases application flexibility.
- DOAS system must be designed properly so that incoming outdoor air does not cause short-circuiting issues with return air of the VRF indoor units, or influence any temperature sensors. The supply temperature of the ventilation system should be carefully controlled to limit cold and hot drafts.

Other Considerations

- Verify that the selected indoor unit type can handle the required amount of outdoor air, taking into account latent and sensible loads, and mixed-air wet-bulb temperatures.
- Location of the space temperature sensors must be considered. Most VRF indoor units can be factory configured to measure space temperature from their respective return air sensors. Integrating outdoor air with the indoor unit can affect this temperature measurement and influence operation, possibly by overcooling or overheating the space. In this situation, a temperature sensor, such as a remote temperature sensor or a sensor located in the VRF system local controller, could be used to establish the actual space temperature.

Refrigerant Piping

Each VRF manufacturer recommends different refrigerant piping sizes and maximum to minimum vertical and horizontal lengths, based on refrigerant volumes and velocities required for efficient and stable system operation. Refer to manufacturer guidelines for specific details and industry and local codes for compliance. System refrigerant charge is a calculated value, whereas additional charge is determined by liquid-line volume.

Manufacturer-specific design software provides detailed refrigerant piping specifications and parameters for each project and application, such as

- Refrigerant liquid and gas piping sizes
- System design verification based on maximum height and length differences
- System design verification based on the ratio of indoor unit to outdoor unit nominal capacity
- Equipment bill of materials/quantities, including system refrigerant piping and charge
- Project numbering and product specifications
- Control and power schematics

Refrigerant Piping Guidelines

Refrigerant piping should be carefully considered, taking into account applicable codes and using risk management strategies. Many national, state, and local building codes require compliance with ASHRAE *Standard* 15 in the design, construction, and installation o f refrigerant piping. It is necessary to follow national, state, and local building codes and work with the local authority having jurisdiction (AHJ) to ensure best practice. Considerations include the following:

- **Inspection:** keep site-installed pipe joints exposed to view until all pressure and vacuum tests are completed and passed.
- **Ventilated spaces**
  Know the refrigerant concentration limit (RCL) and how it applies to each occupied space.
  Evaluate connected spaces beyond the zone and connected ductwork:
  - Plenums: determine whether the space above the ceiling is part of the supply or return system.
  - Closures: if an indoor unit supplies multiple spaces and uses dampers, confirm the minimum open position.
  - Transfer openings: determine whether there is a transfer duct, transfer grill, undercut door, or other permanent opening to an adjoining space.
- **Location of piping and refrigerant bearing components:** know where refrigerant may come from if a leak were to occur.
  - Determine whether the VRF indoor unit coil is in the space.
  - Determine whether refrigerant piping is exposed or in a connected space.
  - Determine whether refrigerant piping is enclosed with a ventilated double-wall jacket.
- **Protect refrigerant piping**
  - Exposed piping
    - Ensure exposed piping is at least 2.2 m above the floor or is against the ceiling.
    - Ensure exposed piping is not installed in an enclosed public stairway, stair landing, or means of egress; consider enclosing piping with gastight and fire-resistive material to isolate from such areas.
  - Shafts and penetrations
    - Ensure piping is not located inside any elevator, dumbwaiter, or other shaft containing moving objects.
    - Ensure piping shaft is not open to living quarters or means of egress.
    - Use riser shafts with proper support between floors.
    - Use protective sleeves to protect piping from abrasions where it passes through walls, obstructions, or other materials.

Controls

VRF manufacturers offer factory-packaged controls that communicate through their system-specific protocol; most use two low-voltage control wires, which must comply with applicable local and national electrical codes. Various individual unit and/or system controllers are available, with the application dictating which controllers need to be installed. Simple controllers include the most basic functions such as operation mode, temperature control, and fan speed. More sophisticated controllers have scheduling, diagnostic functions, and more. Each manufacturer offers centralized control-

lers, which allow the user to monitor and control VRF systems and ancillary equipment from a single location or through the Internet. Manufacturers also offer open protocol communication gateways for higher-level monitoring using BACnet® or LonWorks®, but special programming may be required.

VRF system controls can be subdivided into

- Integral equipment controls
- Local system controls
- Central system controls
- Gateway controls to integrate with open protocol systems

Integral Equipment Controls. VRF air-source outdoor units, water-source units, heat recovery control units, and indoor units include refrigerant and air-side sensing and control devices, which allow the system to optimize its output (e.g., compressor speed, discharge temperatures, fan speed) based on inputs from a remote device. VRF equipment can function as a stand-alone system based only on local inputs.

Local System Controls. VRF indoor units can be controlled individually by their own local controllers, with temperature sensing at the return air or local controller, or several indoor units can be grouped together under one local controller (see Figure 6). Each of the grouped indoor units may operate on or off according to the sensed return air temperature, independent of the other indoor units in the group, but all grouped indoor units will be in the same mode (heating or cooling) to provide air conditioning. Local system controls can include functions such as local set-point control, scheduling and setback capability, cooling/heating/auto modes, and indoor unit fan speed control. Depending on the maximum number of zones served by the local controller and on other factors, additional operation features may be included.

Central System Control. Central control interfaces for VRF systems allow users to monitor and optimize the operation of multiple zones, including any decentralized compatible energy recovery ventilators (see Figure 6). This level of control offers added functionality over local controllers such as seasonal scheduling, remote monitoring and diagnostics, ability to integrate building plans and schematics, and system energy management such as sliding temperature control, optimized start-up control, and setback capabilities. See manufacturer guidelines for specific details. Many of these controls can allow users remote access to operate, monitor, and optimize the VRF system as well as ancillary devices or equipment (e.g., lighting, ventilation, third-party HVAC equipment) without requiring a building-based automation or management network. Access can typically be secured through web-based access licenses or other manufacturer-specific software tools (see Figure 6).

Gateway Control to Integrate with Open Protocol Systems. Open protocol communication gateways allow higher-level monitoring and basic control of set points, fan speeds, mode, etc., via LonWorks or BACnet. Information may be used by the building management system to control other ancillaries such as lighting.

Safety Considerations for Refrigerants

As with any HVAC equipment, VRF systems must include design and application safeguards that protect occupants. The appropriate information for the design, construction, testing, installation, operation, and inspection of mechanical refrigeration systems is ASHRAE *Standard* 15. It is necessary to follow national, state, and local building codes and work with the local AHJ to ensure best practice.

Designers also need to refer to ASHRAE *Standard* 34, which lists the most current information related to refrigerant designations, safety classifications, and refrigerant concentration limits (RCLs). ASHRAE *Standard* 34 refers to common names of refrigerants used in HVAC systems, instead of using the chemical name, formula, or trade name. The standard establishes a uniform system for assigning reference numbers and safety classifications to refrigerants (including blends).

To successfully apply refrigerant safety requirements to a project, the designer must know the following:

- Classification and RCL of refrigerant used
- Classification of occupancy type in which indoor unit and/or piping will be located
- Total amount of refrigerant used in the system
- Individual occupied zone(s) geometry and connected zones, if applicable
- Methodology to calculate the maximum amount of refrigerant that can be safely dispersed into a specific zone

The smallest space in which any of the indoor units or piping could be located must be capable of safely dispersing the refrigerant charge of the entire VRF system in the unlikely event of a catastrophic leak or failure. Examples of spaces that may require additional consideration include bathrooms, small offices, or fire-resistance-rated exit access corridors (as defined in ASHRAE *Standard* 15). It is recommended that the designer use a "fault tree analysis" similar to the following to evaluate the HVAC systems.

Fault Tree Analysis

A fault tree analysis of the installed HVAC systems should be completed to evaluate the placement of system components to minimize the potential for refrigerant leaks into the conditioned space.

The following items serve as a starting point for the fault tree analysis to ensure that all factors are considered to minimize the potential for a refrigerant leak into the conditioned space:

- Identify system components that are in the conditioned space.
- Identify refrigerant piping that is in the conditioned space.
- Identify the smallest occupied space in each HVAC system area and show compliance with the RCL of the refrigerant in use.
- Identify connecting spaces and list the dimensions of the opening between the spaces and the air movement that achieves compliance with the RCL.
- Identify the worst-case refrigerant leak scenario for each system.

Options available to manage smaller spaces where the RCL would otherwise be exceeded include the following:

- If cooling is required in the occupied space, one option is to increase the actual space volume by providing a connected space, as defined in ASHRAE *Standard* 15.
- A ducted indoor unit could serve several smaller offices, thus increasing the overall occupied space served by the system.
- Central VRF systems can be subdivided into a series of smaller systems so that the total charge in a given system does not exceed the RCL limitations for a given space.
- A dedicated system could serve the smaller space(s) so the total charge does not exceed the RCL limitations for a given space.
- Allow the code-required ventilation to maintain conditions in the space.

In summary, complying with ASHRAE *Standard* 15 may only require simple adjustments to the project's design: carefully considering the building's zones, determining connected spaces, and optimally placing the piping and indoor units. With sound engineering practices, a VRF system can be designed to comply with all refrigerant safety requirements and other applicable code requirements.

Integrating VRF Systems to Minimize Environmental Impact

VRF systems include features that make them highly efficient, and that should be applied effectively to optimize system performance and support sustainability. The part-load capabilities of VRF

systems, along with their modular design, zoned approach, heat recovery operation (on some systems), and use of variable-frequency-drive (VFD) compressors, provide comfort conditioning while being optimized to use less energy. VRF systems use industry-accepted refrigerants chosen for their performance and adherence to global protocols. Depending on design outdoor air conditions, building heating loads, and capabilities of the VRF system, the heat pump cycle alone may provide enough heating without adding electric resistance heat.

There has been an increased desire for buildings to be sustainable and energy efficient, and several rating systems and documentation requirements are available that can lead to a "green" building certification. Examples include the Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design (LEED®) certification program developed by the U.S. Green Building Council (USGBC), and the National Green Building Certification developed by National Association of Home Builders (NAHB) in partnership with the International Code Council. These rating systems focus on efficient use of several resources (e.g., water, energy, materials) and promote certain criteria such as an appropriately ventilated indoor environment.

VRF system design has the largest effect on energy use for LEED certification, and may help earn points in the following categories:

- Correct sizing.
- System control: VRF system operations can be controlled centrally through a web-based portal.
- Proper maintenance.
- Correct installation.
- Maximizing heat recovery potential.
- Zone control and energy performance optimization: VRF system operations such as airflow direction control, fan speed, and temperature set points can be controlled through a wall-mounted local remote controller, or centrally through web-based control. Many VRF systems use an inverter-driven compressor, feature simultaneous heating and cooling operation, and include an integrated control system that allows scheduling of equipment in each room. An energy recovery ventilator (ERV) can be installed to further reduce energy usage.
- Commissioning: a VRF controls network assists building commissioning by allowing easy testing, setting, and adjusting of the HVAC system.
- Measurement and verification: energy savings can be estimated using building energy modeling software and comparing the building design with a baseline as defined by ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1. Some VRF system manufacturers offer software or integration to building management systems for ongoing accountability and optimization of building energy consumption, and for monitoring and logging energy consumption, heat recovery cycles, static pressure, and ventilation air volumes. Actual energy usage data can be compared to the model.

VRF systems can also help obtain points for indoor air quality (IAQ):

- Some VRF systems can meet minimum outdoor air requirements through ventilation connections of the indoor units.
- In applications where more outdoor air is required, an ERV can be installed; when used with adequate air distribution from ducted units, this can increase ventilation rates above ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 requirements.
- In a construction IAQ management plan, the ERV can be used to flush the building before occupancy.
- For indoor chemical and pollutant source control, many VRF system indoor evaporator units can be installed with a filter (consult a designer to ensure adequate static pressure is available to provide desired airflow performance). An ERV can also be integrated with a sensor to monitor CO_2 levels, and then operate accordingly.

7. COMMISSIONING

Effective commissioning of a VRF system is fundamental to future system performance (e.g., space comfort, operating efficiency, expected life cycle). The installed VRF system should be thoroughly pressure and vacuum tested before joints are insulated or closed in the wall, to identify leaks or other system related issues. Should system defects be identified, they must be resolved before the commissioning process can be completed. This resolution may involve repurging the lines with nitrogen, rebrazing piping connections, and/or reassembling flared joints, etc. Follow the manufacturer's recommendations on pressure and vacuum testing.

The VRF system should then be thoroughly evacuated to remove all air and moisture. Evacuation can also identify leaks that do not show up during pressure testing. Evacuation can take several days to effectively implement, especially if the system is large or contains a significant amount of moisture.

Accurately establishing and verifying the design system refrigerant charge is critical. Manufacturers piping design software typically provides the contractor with an additional system charge calculation based on liquid pipe length and diameter. Verification of total charge requirements based on the installed system parameters and via manual calculations as directed in equipment installation and operating documentation is recommended. Under- or overcharging can result in performance issues.

Because standard VRF systems are equipped with comprehensive diagnostic tools, the manufacturer's full commissioning procedure must be carried out to obtain full benefit and verify that the complete system is operating correctly in all modes. Detailed commissioning checklists should be completed to demonstrate that the procedure has been followed, and to record the data for future reference.

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CHAPTER 19

DUCT CONSTRUCTION

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THIS chapter covers construction of HVAC and exhaust duct systems for residential, commercial, and industrial applications.

1. BUILDING CODE REQUIREMENTS

New construction and renovation projects are normally governed by local ordinances or state laws requiring compliance with specific health, safety, property protection, or energy conservation regulations. The relationship between laws, ordinances, codes, and standards that affect design and construction of HVAC duct systems is shown in Figure 1 (note that the figure may not list all applicable regulations and standards for a specific locality). Local building ordinances typically invoke NFPA *Standard*s 90A and 90B, or some variation thereof, along with one or more national building codes for HVAC duct system construction and installation.

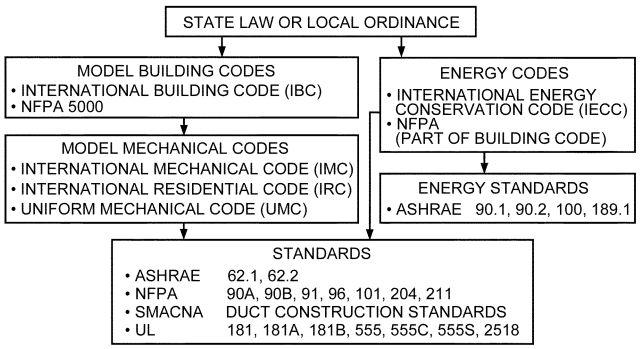

Fig. 1 Hierarchy of Building Codes and Standards

Since codes and standards are developed independently and revised on consistent or non-consistent schedules, the most recent edition of a code or standard may not have been adopted by a local jurisdiction or locality. Local jurisdictions may also include amendments and additions to various sections of a referenced building code. HVAC designers must know which code edition applies to their designs. If a provision conflicts with the design intent, the designer should resolve the issue with local building officials. New or different construction methods can be accommodated by the provisions for equivalency incorporated into codes.

2. PRESSURE CLASSIFICATIONS

Duct construction static pressure classifications typically used on contract drawings and specifications are summarized by Table 1. The classifications are from SMACNA (2020) for sheet metal ductwork, and NAIMA (2002a) for fibrous glass duct board. Negative-pressure flat oval duct systems can be designed by using 2500 Pa sheet gages with the negative-pressure rectangular duct reinforcement members mechanically attached or welded to the duct. The most common flexible air ducts and air connectors are listed up to 2500 Pa maximum positive-pressure ratings and anywhere from 125 to 500 Pa negative-pressure ratings, but there are listed flexible ducts with pressures as high as 4000 Pa and as low as –3000 Pa. Designers should refer to the specific flex duct manufacturer's recommended operating conditions for continuous performance recommendations.

Air conveyed by a duct adds both static pressure and velocity pressure loads on the duct's structure. The load from static pressure differential across the duct wall normally dominates and the mean static pressure is generally used for duct pressure classification. Turbulent airflow adds relatively low but rapidly pulsating loading on the duct wall.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 5.2, Duct Design.

Table 1 Pressure Classification for Ductwork[a]

	Static Pressure Class, Pa													
Type Duct	**+125**	**–125**	**+250**	**–250**	**+500**	**–500**	**+750**	**–750**	**+1000**	**–1000**	**+1500**	**–1500**	**+2500**	**–2500**
Rectangular	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●
Round						●				●		●	●	●
Spiral flat oval													●	●[b]
Longitudinal flat oval													●	●[b]
Fibrous glass duct board[c]	●	●	●	●	●	●								
Flexible duct[d] (wire: helix type)	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●	●

Notes:
[a]Columns with a dot indicate that construction standards are available for the pressure classes shown.
[b]Same reinforcement as rectangular duct, except reinforcement mechanically attached to duct.
[c]Fibrous glass duct board must be UL *Standard* 181 listed.
[d]Flexible duct must be UL *Standard* 181 listed and labeled.

Duct design is based on **total pressure** calculations as discussed in Chapter 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. From these calculations, the designer should specify the static pressure classification of the various duct sections in the system. All modes of operation must be considered, especially in systems used for smoke management and those with fire dampers that must close when the system is running.

3. DUCT CLEANING

Ducts can collect dirt and moisture, which can contribute to microbial growth. Design, construct, and maintain ducts and attached HVAC system components to minimize the opportunity for growth and dissemination of microorganisms. As described by NIH (2015), recommended control measures to reduce duct contamination include (1) locating air intakes away from contaminant sources, (2) providing and maintaining proper air filtration, (3) sealing ductwork during construction to prevent debris from entering, (4) inspecting new ductwork for oil or debris prior to system startup and cleaning if needed, and (5) implementing good housekeeping in occupied spaces.

Owners should routinely inspect ducts for cleanliness. If cleaning is needed, contaminant sources should be identified and controlled before cleaning is performed. NADCA (2021) and NAIMA (2002b) provide specific information and procedures for cleaning ducts. Fabric duct systems should be cleaned (washed) in accordance with manufacturer's instructions. To minimize air leakage after duct sections are opened or disconnected, attention should be given to properly closing, connecting, and resealing them (see the section on HVAC System Leakage). Also, any duct insulation removed must be replaced, and vapor barriers (if used) must be resealed.

Commentary: According to the Air Duct Council (ADC 2021), the "cleaning" of air ducts, including flexible ducts, has become a common practice. If cleaning of flexible ducts is undertaken, the ADC recommends that dust and debris be removed from inside flexible ducts by qualified technicians following procedures outlined by the National Air Duct Cleaners Association (NADCA) or other nationally recognized duct cleaning organization. ADC has investigated the removal of dust and debris from the inside of flexible ducts using the rotating brush and vacuum process per NADCA procedures. Investigation after the use of this process did not indicate damage caused to the inner liner of the flexible ducts caused by the cleaning process. ADC does caution that flexible duct inner liners may be damaged by overly aggressive contaminant removal techniques, such as high-pressure blow guns, air skipper, and air whips. When the process is completed, any flexible duct connections that were opened to clean the duct must be properly resealed to maintain airtightness and duct thermal properties. Whenever dust and debris removal from flexible ducts is considered, the owner should consider replacement, especially if the air distribution system is 15 years old or more. The opportunity to replace a duct system using new ducts that meet or exceed current R-value insulation requirements and much tighter installation methods would not only provide clean ducts, but also provide lower energy costs to operate the system.

4. HVAC SYSTEM LEAKAGE

For the purposes of this chapter, **ductwork** includes straight duct, flexible duct, sheet metal and rigid fiberglass plenums, and fittings (e.g., elbows, transitions, tees, wyes) for distribution and extraction of air. It does not include duct-mounted components (e.g., terminal units, access doors/panels, attenuators, coils, fire/smoke dampers, balancing and control dampers). A **system** consists of the supply air handler, return fan, exhaust fan, plenums, and all ductwork that connects the air handler to the conditioned space. The system also includes duct-mounted components where leaks through joints or penetrations can occur. However, leakage from the occupied space into a return air plenum is not included.

Commentary: Return air plenums are part of the air path from the conditioned space back to the air handler. Therefore, they are part of the system. As described in the examples that follow in this section, the thermal effects of unintended leakage directly from the supply system into the return plenum must be accounted for differently than if the supply system leaked directly to the conditioned space. UMC (2021) does not allow plenum return systems for health care facilities.

HVAC system air leakage increases building energy consumption. It also reduces the system's ability to control and deliver intended flows and pressures, and to manage the extraction and dilution of contaminants. Also, leakage can cause noise problems, drafts in the conditioned space, and dirt and dust deposits on the duct exterior. Leakage energy impacts depend on building and system type. For small buildings with single-zone air distribution systems served by equipment such as packaged rooftop cooling units and furnaces (e.g., houses, commercial buildings with floor area less than 2300 m^2), 75 to 95% of the HVAC site energy is used for space heating and cooling (Thornton et al. 2010; Walker and Sherman 2008; Zhang et al. 2010), and the impacts are mostly on the thermal side. For large buildings with central multizone air distribution systems served by equipment such as central chillers and boilers (e.g., mid- and high-rise offices, supermarkets and retail stores with a floor area of 2300 m^2 or more), 20 to 80% of HVAC site energy is used by fans (Huang et al. 1991; Leach et al. 2009, 2010) and the impacts are also on fan power. All these effects are strongly influenced by the location of leaks relative to conditioned space.

If supply air leaks to an unconditioned attic or crawlspace, or to the outdoors, the lost heating or cooling must be replaced. In this case, heating or cooling fluid flows or temperature differences must increase, or the system must run longer to meet the load. If, instead, supply air leaks to a ceiling return plenum adjacent to conditioned spaces, the fan must run faster or longer, and the largest impact may be on fan power. The heat associated with this added fan power also creates an additional cooling load. The effects of return leakage can also be significant. For example, leaks from a hot attic into a return duct heat the return air, which in turn reduces system cooling capacity.

Because the relationship between fan power and airflow is somewhere between a quadratic and cubic function, depending on the system type (Sherman and Wray 2010), an increase in airflow to provide the desired service and compensate for system leakage means that fan energy consumption increases significantly. Field measurements by Diamond et al. (2003) showed that a leaky VAV system (10% leakage upstream and 10% downstream of terminal box inlet dampers at operating conditions) uses 25 to 35% more fan energy than a tight system (2.5% upstream and 2.5% downstream at operating conditions). For an exhaust system with 20% leakage, the fan has to move 25% more air to meet the specified flows at the grilles, which causes fan power to increase 95%.

System Sealing

It is recommended that all ductwork and plenum transverse joints, longitudinal seams, and duct penetrations, including damper shafts, be sealed. Longitudinal seams are joints in the direction of airflow. Transverse joints are connections of two duct sections, with the connections oriented perpendicular to airflow. Openings for rotating shafts, wires, and pipes or tubes should be sealed with bushings or other devices that minimize air leakage but that do not inter-

fere with shaft rotation or prevent thermal expansion. Sealing that meets these requirements is in compliance with ASHRAE *Standards* 90.1-2022 and 189.1-2017, the *International Mechanical Code*® (IMC 2021), the *International Energy Conservation Code*® (IECC 2021), the *International Residential Code*® (IRC 2021), and the *Uniform Mechanical Code*® (UMC 2021). Spiral lock seams need not be sealed.

Sealing that would void product listings, such as for fire/smoke dampers, is not recommended. However, low-leakage duct-mounted components, including terminal units, reheat coils, and access doors, should be specified so that the combined HVAC system air leakage will not exceed criteria set by the designer, *ASHRAE Handbook*, standards, and codes. For example, some manufacturers of UL-listed and -labeled fire/smoke dampers allow sealing and gasketing of breakaway duct/sleeve connections; all can provide sealed non-breakaway duct/sleeve connections.

Sealants

General. All tape, mastic, rolled mastic sealants, aerosol/spray applied sealants, gaskets, and nonmetallic mechanical fasteners should

- Be used in compliance with the manufacturer's instructions
- Be tested to UL *Standard* 723 (ASTM *Standard* E84) and have a flame spread index equal to or less than 25 and a smoke developed index equal to or less than 50
- Maintain their airtightness over the service life of the component to which they are applied

Sheet Metal Ductwork. All joints, longitudinal and transverse seams, and connections in sheet metal ductwork should be securely fastened and sealed with welds, gaskets, tapes, mastics, mastic-plus-embedded-fabric systems, rolled mastic sealants, or aerosol sealants. Sealants should be (1) UL listed, labeled, and used in accordance with their listing; and (2) tested for durability using the accelerated aging procedure in ASTM *Standard* E2342. Sherman (2005) recommended that the time-to-failure acceptance criterion should be at least 60 days, because this time period delineated which tapes failed early using accelerated aging compared to tapes that lasted much longer.

Tapes should be used only on joints between parallel surfaces, or on right-angle flat joints. If mastic or tape is used to seal openings greater than 6 mm, the combination of mastic or either mesh or tape should be used. Heat-sensitive and heat-activated tapes, which are designed specifically to seal fibrous glass ductboard, should not be used as a sealant on metal ducts. Cloth-backed, rubber-adhesive duct tape should not be used, regardless of UL designation, unless such tape is used in combination with mastic and draw bands or it has been approved by the authority having jurisdiction for use without mastic.

For exterior applications, mastics should be tested using ASTM *Standard* C732 artificial weathering tests and show no signs of visible degradation (e.g., washout, slump, cracking, loss of adhesion) after being exposed to artificial weathering.

Commentary: Apart from UL *Standard* 723, there is no UL standard for sealant performance when it is applied to sheet metal ductwork. It is recommended that a standard be developed for sheet metal applications and it should include or refer to a durability test.

Rigid Fiberglass Ductwork. Rigid fiberglass ductboard should be sealed following the NAIMA (2002a) standard using materials listed and labeled to the UL *Standard* 181A standard. There are three closure and air sealing systems for fiberglass duct board. The first two use tapes (marked "181A-P" or "181A-H"); the third system is a fiberglass mesh and mastic system (marked "181A-M"). In the latter case, a layer of mastic is applied to the joint, a strip of fiberglass mesh is embedded into the mastic, and then a finish coat of mastic is applied over the mesh.

Flexible Duct. Tapes and mastics used to close flexible air ducts and air connectors should be listed and labeled to UL *Standard* 181B, Part 1 or Part 2; be marked "181B-FX" or "181B-M," respectively; and be used in accordance with their listing.

Mechanical fasteners for use with nonmetallic flexible air ducts and air connectors should be either stainless steel worm-drive gear clamps or nonmetallic straps listed and labeled to UL *Standard* 181B, Part 3, and be marked "181B-C." Nonmetallic fasteners should have a minimum tensile strength rating of 670 N and be suitable for continuous use at the maximum temperature to which they will be exposed. When nonmetallic fasteners are used, beaded fittings are required, and the maximum duct positive operating pressure should be limited to 1500 Pa.

Commentary: Sherman (2005) showed that some nonmetallic flexible duct core-to-collar clamps have unacceptable high-temperature performance. Most of the standard nylon straps failed before the two-year test period was completed. Sherman concluded that UL *Standard* 181B testing of these clamps does not adequately address this issue, and recommended that straps be rated for continuous use at 93°C. A more flexible requirement is that they be suitable for continuous use at the maximum temperature to which they will be exposed. A new test method for determining the durability of clamping systems should be developed to test the actual failure modes found in the field. Such a test could be incorporated in UL testing or be a separate ASTM (or equivalent ANSI) test method.

Leakage Testing

Rationale. System leakage testing, including ducts and duct-mounted components, is recommended, because leakage data collected by researchers over several years (1998 through 2004) for 10 systems in nine U.S. large commercial buildings (see Figure 2 in Wray et al. [2005]) showed that seven had substantial leakage flows (10 to 26%). The other three systems had much smaller leakage flows (3 to 4%). These data include variable-air-volume (VAV), constant-air-volume (CAV), and dual-duct systems, and both high-pressure (main) and low-pressure (branch) system sections. The distinction between main and branch sections is their location relative to terminal box inlet dampers. For VAV systems, data include fan-powered and cooling-only boxes. Most systems supplied air through square diffusers, but some used slot diffusers. Ductwork pressurization tests conducted by Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory (LBNL) on the same nine buildings at a test pressure of 250 Pa also showed that, on average, the leakage area for branches was about three times more than for mains (see Figure 1 in Wray et al. [2005]).

Scope. It is recommended that supply air (both upstream and downstream of the VAV box primary air inlet damper, when used), return air, and independent exhaust air systems be tested for air leakage at operating conditions to verify (1) good workmanship, and (2) the use of low-leakage components as required to not exceed the maximum allowable system air leakage. An independent exhaust air system comprises air discharged from a space to the outdoors by a system not coupled to supply or return air systems.

Testing these particular systems is important because of the potentially significant energy impacts. As a minimum, 25% of the system, based on duct surface area, should be tested and another 25% if any of the initial sections fail. If any section of the second 25% fails, the entire system should be tested. Sections should be selected randomly by the owner's representative. These leakage tests should be conducted by an independent party responsible to the owner's representative after the system sections to be tested are

fully assembled but before the installation of insulation and concealment of ductwork.

To ensure that a system passes its air leakage test at operating conditions, ductwork sections should be leak tested by pressurization during construction. To supplement these construction-phase tests, leakage of duct-mounted components should be determined by specification and certified leakage data provided with equipment submittals. Leakage of air-handling units should be determined by specification and verification leakage tests.

Procedures. Test procedures based on ductwork pressurization should comply with industry practice (e.g., AABC 2016, Chapter 5; ASHRAE *Standard* 126-2020: Section 7; EUROVENT 2/2 1996; SMACNA 2012: Sections 4, 6, and 7).

Leakage test procedures currently used by industry focus on determining component airtightness (e.g., for supply air ductwork located upstream of terminal box inlet dampers). Airtightness alone, however, is insufficient to determine leakage airflows. It is important to also then estimate system pressures during operation to fully determine these flows. Determining the location of every leak and the pressure difference across individual leaks is practically impossible for most systems, and such an approach can lead to significant uncertainty and error.

To eliminate the uncertainty associated with estimating pressure differences across leaks, ASHRAE *Standard* 215-2018 (RA 2021) provides a method of test for determining leakage airflows and fractional leakage during system operation (either for the whole system or for selected parts). Flows into and out of the section being tested are measured at a repeatable reference operating condition: the only variable is leakage flow. It can be used for both new and existing buildings, but is currently limited to single-duct supply and independent exhaust air systems. The method outlined in this standard does not replace ductwork pressurization leakage testing.

Acceptance Criteria. It is important to differentiate between standards that describe how ducts or systems are to be pressure tested for leakage (e.g., AABC 2016, Chapter 5; ASHRAE *Standard* 126-2020: Section 7; EUROVENT 2/2 1996; SMACNA 2012: Sections 4, 6, and 7) and standards that dictate maximum permitted leakage (e.g., ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1-2022; 2022 California Green Building Standards Code). The former may contain recommendations for the amount of leakage that can be expected for certain types of construction. However, these recommendations should not be mistaken for the maximum permitted leakage in building codes, energy codes, or owner requirements. It is recommended that duct and system leakage requirements be clearly stated in the contract documents.Figure 2

To enable proper accounting of leakage-related impacts on fan energy use and space conditioning loads, the design engineer should establish the maximum allowable system leakage for each fan system as a percentage of fan airflow at a reference system operating condition. Recommended test pressures and maximum system leakage fractions are shown in Table 2.

Five percent system leakage is attainable in large commercial buildings, as evidenced by the supply systems with low leakage (3 to 4%) reported by Wray et al. (2005). Also, Wray and Matson (2003) indicate that system leakage operating cost impacts are about $1.50 to $1.94 per square metre of duct surface area for a 20% leaky supply system compared to a 5% leaky system in a large commercial building with ceiling return plenums. System sealing costs vary with fitting-to-straight-duct ratio, pressure class, and other system variables. According to Tsal et al. (1998), an upper bound for the one-time cost of duct sealing is $2.71/m^2 of duct surface area. Using these costs, the payback period for achieving 5% leakage compared to 20% leakage is about 1 to 2 years. The recommended 5% value may be modified when further life-cycle cost analysis data become available.

Supply and return sections that leak to/from outdoors should be tighter than indoor sections, because the added thermal losses/gains from these leaks increase energy impacts. For example, an airtight VAV supply system with a design fan pressure rise of 1000 Pa, a design fan flow of 6600 L/s, and a total efficiency of 60% will require about 11,000 W of power. With 5% leakage and applying an exponent of 2.4 to the flow ratio (1.05), the fan power increases by about 12% or 1400 W. Assuming that 12.8°C air is supplied to maintain a room temperature of 23.3°C, the supply air energy lost to outdoors by the 350 L/s of leakage is about 4600 W and the total energy impact of the leakage is about 6000 W. To achieve the same total energy impact as only the fan power increase with 5% leakage, leakage for the outdoor sections would need to be limited to about 1%.

However, this analysis is overly simplified, because it ignores the thermal impacts of leakage if the supply sections were located indoors instead. In some cases, the thermal impacts of leakage from indoor sections may be as much as the related fan power impacts. Accounting for these thermal effects is more complicated because of interactive system effects (e.g., supply-leakage-related cooling of a ceiling return plenum, which in turn reduces ceiling heat transfer to adjacent cooler conditioned spaces, and thus reduces supply airflows needed to manage space cooling loads). Energy simulation programs have been used to conduct detailed analyses of the time-varying thermal and fan power effects of supply leakage in large commercial buildings (e.g., Wray and Matson 2003; Wray and Sherman 2010). The simulation results are generally consistent with field measurements (e.g., Diamond et al. 2003), but further validation of coupled load and system leakage models, such as those in EnergyPlus, is still needed.

For buildings without static pressure control of the conditioned space (e.g., a midrise apartment building), exhaust sections that draw in indoor air through leaks need to be tighter than outdoor exhaust sections because the leakage flow also tends to depressurize the building and increase building air infiltration (assuming that the fan has been adjusted to still provide the design airflow at the exhaust inlets). The ratio of the change in infiltration flow to the change in exhaust flow from leakage depends on environmentally driven pressures, which can vary widely depending on weather. A reasonable average for this ratio is about 0.6 (Woolley et al. 2014). For example, an exhaust system with a design fan pressure rise of 500 Pa, a design fan flow of 2360 L/s, and a total efficiency of 60% requires about 2300 W of power. With 5% leakage and applying an exponent of 3 to the flow ratio (1.05), the fan power increases by about 16%, or 310 W. Using a ratio of 0.6, the change in infiltration due to the 5% leakage (about 123 L/s) will be about 75 L/s. If the outdoor design temperature is 0°C and the conditioned space is heated to a temperature of 22.2°C, the energy associated with increased infiltration is about 3900 W and the total energy impact of the leakage is about 4200 W. To achieve the same total energy impact as only the fan power increase with 5% leakage, leakage in this case will need to be limited to about 0.4%. Even tighter systems are required for colder outdoor design temperatures, whereas outdoor temperatures closer to the conditioned space temperature will allow more leakage (to a maximum of 5%).

As a compromise so that the designer does not need to carry out additional calculations for supply and return sections that leak to/from outdoors and for exhaust sections that draw in indoor air through leaks, it is recommended that leakage for these sections be limited to 2%.

Leakage Class. Leakage class, as specified by ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1-2022, can be translated to fractional (%) leakage using Equation (1) or Table 3.

Table 2 Recommended Maximum System Leakage Percentages

Type of System	System Condition	Test Pressure,[a,b] Pa	Maximum Fan System[c] Leakage
1. Fractional kilowatt systems, small exhaust/return systems, residential systems	Operating	Operating pressure	5%
	During construction	125	5%
2. Single-zone supply, return, or exhaust systems	Operating	Operating pressure	5%
	During construction	500	5%
3. Multizone supply, return, or exhaust systems	Operating	Operating pressure	5%
	During construction	500	5%
4. Dual-duct supply systems, both hot and cold ducts	Operating	Operating pressure	5%
	During construction	1500	5%
5. VAV[d] and CAV[d] supply systems	Operating	Operating pressure	5%
	During construction	Upstream box: 1000	5%
		Downstream box: 250	5%
6. VAV[d] or CAV[d] return systems	Operating	Operating pressure	5%
	During construction	Downstream box: 750	5%
		Upstream box: 250	5%
7. Chilled-beam systems	Operating	Operating pressure	5%
	During construction	1000	5%
8. High-pressure induction systems	Operating	Operating pressure	5%
	During construction	1500	5%
9. Supply and return ductwork located outdoors	Operating	Operating pressure	2%
	During construction	750	2%
10. Exhaust ductwork located indoors	Operating	Operating pressure	2%
	During construction	750	2%
11. Air-handling units	Site test by manufacturer	Specified design pressure	1%

Notes:

[a]Test pressure should not exceed duct pressure rating.
[b]It is recommended that duct pressure rating equal fan shutoff pressure if possibility of fan shutoff exists either in VAV systems or in systems with smoke/fire damper control.
[c]A fan system includes ductwork upstream and downstream of the fan. The fan system also includes components mounted to that ductwork where leaks through joints or penetrations can occur. However, leakage from the occupied space into a return air plenum is not included. Separate leakage specifications should be used for upstream and downstream sections.
[d]Assuming primary air damper located at box inlet. If damper is at box outlet, then box should be included in upstream leakage testing.

$$Q_{leak,frac} = 100 \frac{C_L \Delta p^{0.65}}{Q_{fan,norm}} \quad (1)$$

where

$Q_{leak,frac}$ = leakage fraction of fan airflow, %
C_L = leakage class, L/s per $Pa^{0.65}$ per 10 m^2 of duct surface area
Δp = system pressure difference, Pa
$Q_{fan,norm}$ = normalized fan airflow, L/s per m^2 of duct surface area

For example, for a leakage class of 0.0056 L/s per $Pa^{0.65}$ per m^2 of duct surface area with a pressure difference of 750 Pa and an inlet flow of 10.2 L/s per m^2 of duct surface area, the fractional leakage is 4.1%. For a pressure difference of 1500 Pa, the fractional leakage is 6.4%.

Calculating Test Section Allowable Leakage. Determine from the drawings the airflow and duct surface area in each section and then calculate the allowable leakage (see Example 1).

If an entire system or section of ductwork is not to be tested, determine the allowed leakage in the test section. To do this, determine the surface area of the test section, and divide that by the total surface area of the entire section. Multiply this test section leakage percentage by the section airflow to determine the test section leakage airflow.

Example 1. A system consists of three sections, with airflow and surface areas as summarized in Table 4. Determine the allowable leakage for a 836 m^2 surface area section of Section 1 identified by the owner's representative. Branch 3 is located outdoors.

Solution. Table 5 summarizes the calculations. By test, the 464 m^2 test section cannot exceed 330 L/s at 1000 Pa.

Responsibilities

Refer to definitions of terms **ductwork** and **system** found at beginning of HVAC System Leakage section.

The **engineer** should

- Specify HVAC system components, duct-mounted equipment, accessories, sealants, and sealing procedures that together can meet the system airtightness design objective.
- Inspect the system during construction for quality of workmanship and to verify that correct duct-mounted components and air-handling units are installed.
- Specify the *construction-stage* ductwork leakage test standard or procedures
- Specify the *construction-stage* test pressures to the nearest 25 Pa that are expected during operation at design conditions and that do not exceed the pressure class rating of the ductwork.
- Specify the *construction-stage* maximum allowable leakage class for ductwork, and the maximum allowable leakage for system components, duct mounted equipment, and accessories.
- Specify the maximum allowable *operating system* leakage airflow, the corresponding fractional leakage, and their maximum allowable uncertainty, as determined using ASHRAE *Standard* 215-2018 (RA 2021).
- Review and approve the sheet metal and test contractors' leakage test reports. If any system has a leakage failure, the engineer should discuss remedies with the sheet metal contractor, vendor, and/or owner's representative.

Table 3 Leakage as Percentage of Flow

Airtightness Class EUROVENT,* L/s per 10 m² per Pa^0.65	Q_{fan}/A_S, L/(s·m²) Duct Surface Area	Static Pressure, Pa								
		125	250	500	750	1000	1250	1500	2000	2500
K (0.81)	10.2	18.4	28.9	45.3	58.9	71.1	82.2	92.5	100	100
	12.7	14.7	23.1	36.2	47.2	56.8	65.7	74.0	89.2	100
	15.2	12.3	19.2	30.2	39.3	47.4	54.8	61.7	74.3	85.9
	20.3	9.2	14.4	22.6	29.5	35.5	41.1	46.2	55.8	64.5
	25.4	7.4	11.5	18.1	33.6	28.4	32.9	37.0	44.6	51.6
A (0.27)	10.2	6.1	9.6	15.1	19.6	23.7	27.4	30.8	37.2	43.0
	12.7	4.9	7.7	12.1	15.7	18.9	21.0	24.7	29.7	34.4
	15.2	4.1	6.4	10.1	13.1	15.8	18.3	20.6	24.8	28.6
	20.3	3.1	4.8	7.5	9.8	11.8	13.7	15.4	18.6	21.5
	25.4	2.5	3.8	6.0	7.9	9.5	11.0	12.3	14.9	17.2
B (0.09)	10.2	2.0	3.2	5.0	6.5	7.9	9.1	10.3	12.4	14.3
	12.7	1.6	2.6	4.0	5.2	6.3	7.3	8.2	9.9	11.5
	15.2	1.4	2.1	3.4	4.4	5.3	6.1	6.9	8.3	9.5
	20.3	1.0	1.6	2.5	3.3	3.9	4.6	5.1	6.2	7.2
	25.4	0.8	1.3	2.0	2.6	3.2	3.7	4.1	5.0	5.7
C (0.03)	10.2	0.7	1.1	1.7	2.2	2.6	3.0	3.4	4.1	4.8
	12.7	0.5	0.9	1.3	1.7	2.1	2.4	2.7	3.3	3.8
	15.2	0.5	0.7	1.1	1.5	1.8	2.0	2.3	2.8	3.2
	20.3	0.3	0.5	0.8	1.1	1.3	1.5	1.7	2.1	2.4
	25.4	0.3	0.4	0.7	0.9	1.1	1.2	1.4	1.7	1.9
D (0.01)	10.2	0.2	0.4	0.6	0.7	0.9	1.0	1.1	1.4	1.6
	12.7	0.2	0.2	0.4	0.6	0.7	0.8	0.9	1.1	1.3
	15.2	0.2	0.2	0.4	0.5	0.6	0.7	0.8	0.9	1.1
	20.3	0.1	0.3	0.3	0.4	0.4	0.5	0.6	0.7	0.8
	25.4	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.3	0.4	0.4	0.5	0.6	0.6

*Airtightness classes K and D are not EUROVENT 2/2 (1996) designations, but are used by some countries in Europe.

Table 4 Example 1 System Parameters

Section	Airflow, L/s	Surface Area, m²	L/(s·m²)	Allowable Leakage, %	Allowable Leakage, L/s
1 (main)	11 800	836	14.1	5	590
2 (branch)	4 700	372	12.6	5	235
3 (branch)	7 100	464	15.3	2	142
Total	23 600	1672	14.1	4.1	967

Table 5 Solution for Example 1

Section	Surface Area, m²		Test Section Leakage, % (Test Section Area Fraction, m² / Section Surface Area, m²)	Section Airflow, L/s	Allowable Leakage, %	Allowable Leakage, L/s
1 (main)	Under test	464	0.56	6608	5	330
	Not tested	372	0.44	5192	5	260
Total		**836**	**1.00**	**11 800**	**5**	**590**

The **sheet metal contractor** should

- Construct the system using quality workmanship and correct duct-mounted components and air-handling units. If any installed duct-mounted equipment appears to be leakage suspect, the contractor should discuss remedies with the engineer and/or owner's representative.
- Conduct *ductwork* leakage pressurization tests during *construction*. As a minimum, 25% of the ductwork (based on duct surface area) should be tested during construction, and another 25% if any of the initial sections fail. If any section of the second 25% fails, all of the ductwork should be leak tested.
- Provide connections for test apparatus, and separate test sections from each other as needed so that the test apparatus capacity is not exceeded.

- Report test results and, where required, take corrective action to seal ductwork and absorb the cost for conducting related additional leak tests.

The **test contractor** should

- Conduct the *operating system* leakage test in compliance with ASHRAE *Standard* 215-2018 (RA 2021).
- Report test results, including reasons for any failures.

It should be the responsibility of the **owner or owner's representative** to provide direction upon request.

5. AIR-HANDLING UNIT LEAKAGE

Custom-designed air-handling units (AHUs) should be leak tested after the AHU is reassembled on site with all penetrations (e.g., for controls, electrical, and piping) in place and sealed. Leakage tests should be conducted by the AHU manufacturer in accordance with ASHRAE *Standard* 126-2020, Section 7, at design operating pressures (positive and negative) specified by the design engineer, and be witnessed by a representative of the owner. AHUs should be shipped with blankoffs and a round flanged opening for the flow meter/blower leakage test unit.

It is recommended that packaged AHUs also be leak tested. The casing leakage for AHUs should not exceed 1% of design airflow at the specified design pressure.

6. RESIDENTIAL AND COMMERCIAL DUCT CONSTRUCTION

Terminology

Construction materials for nonmetallic rigid and flexible ducts are listed in UL *Standard* 181.

Air duct. A rigid or flexible duct that passes all applicable UL *Standard* 181 tests. These tests include surface burning characteristics (ASTM *Standard* E84), flame penetration, burning, corrosion, mold growth and humidity, temperature, puncture, static load, impact, erosion, pressure, collapse, tension, torsion, bending, and leakage. Flexible air ducts are identified with a square or rectangular listing mark indicating the product is a Class 0 or Class 1 air duct.

Air connector. A flexible duct tested to 13 of the 16 required UL *Standard* 181 tests. Flame penetration, impact, and puncture testing are not required for air connector approval. Flexible air connectors are identified with a round listing mark indicating the product is a Class 0 or Class 1 air connector.

Class 0. Air duct or air connector having a flame spread index and smoke developed index of zero determined in accordance with UL *Standard* 723 (ASTM *Standard* E84).

Class 1. Air duct or air connector having a flame spread index not over 25, without evidence of continued progressive combustion, and a smoke developed index of not over 50, determined in accordance with UL *Standard* 723 (ASTM *Standard* E84).

Flexible air connector. See *air connector*.

Flexible air duct. See *air duct*.

Flexible duct. A *flexible air duct* or *flexible air connector*.

Commentary:

1. Listed flexible air ducts and flexible air connectors are required by UL 181 to have a listing label applied every 3.0 m or fraction thereof during the manufacturing process as part of their listing. However, installed ducts can be shorter than 3.0 m; thus, a label might not be present under the current labeling requirements.
2. It is recommended that UL 181 markings be increased in size, prominence, and frequency to facilitate verification of duct classification between flexible air duct and flexible air connector.

Specifications should indicate the requirement for the use of flexible air ducts or flexible air connectors as appropriate for the conditions under which they are to be installed.

Buildings and Spaces

Typically, codes (IMC, IRC, UMC, IAPMO) and local ordinances invoke NFPA *Standards* 90A and 90B or some variation thereof. NFPA *Standard* 90A covers the following buildings and spaces:

- Buildings of combustible construction (Types III, IV and IV; for definition of construction types, see IBC [2015], Chapter 6) over three stories in height, regardless of volume
- Spaces over 708 m^3 in volume
- Buildings and spaces not covered by other applicable NFPA standards

NFPA *Standard* 90B covers the following dwellings and spaces:

- One- and two-story dwellings
- Spaces not exceeding 708 m^3 in volume in any occupancy

NFPA 90A Materials. Ducts must be constructed of steel, aluminum, copper, concrete, masonry, clay tile, or Class 0 or Class 1 flexible air duct tested in accordance with UL *Standard* 181 and installed in conformance with the conditions of their listing. Flexible ducts must not be used as vertical ducts serving more than two adjacent stories in height and must not penetrate fire-resistance-rated assemblies or construction.

Steel and aluminum construction must comply with *SMACNA Duct Construction Standards—Metal and Flexible* (2005). Refer to Tables 6A, 6B, and 6C for the relationship between gage and nominal/minimum thickness for galvanized steel, uncoated steel, and stainless steel sheet thickness. For galvanized ducts, a Z180 coating (ASTM *Standard* A653M) is commonly used for dry indoor applications because the small amount of corrosion that may occur causes only discoloration in 20 to 30 years. For outdoor exposures or wet indoor applications, the galvanized duct coating should be Z270 minimum. The average years to first rust for Z275 coatings located outdoors depends on the environment: 3 to 7 years for severe industrial, 15 to 20 for rural, 7 to 10 for Atlantic coast marine, 12 for suburban, and 10 for urban (Stratton 2000).

NFPA 90B Materials. Supply ducts must be made of the following materials:

- Galvanized steel or aluminum having a minimum thickness per the standard/code having jurisdiction (NFPA 90B [2021: Table 4.5.1.1.1]; IMC [2021: 603.4], IRC [2021: Table M1601.1.1]; UMC [2021: Article 602.1]), or
- Class 0 or Class 1 rigid or flexible air duct tested in accordance with UL 181 and installed in conformance with the conditions of their listing. Rigid or flexible ducts must not be used as a vertical duct that is more than two stories in height and must not penetrate fire-resistance-rated assemblies or construction.

Return ducts governed by NFPA 90B (2021) must be constructed of metal, 25 mm nominal wood boards, or other material provided that the material is not more flammable than 25 mm wood boards. Return ductwork under the jurisdiction of a code is commonly constructed in accordance with SMACNA (2020). For galvanized ducts, a Z180 coating is recommended (ASTM *Standard* A653M).

Commentary. UMC (2021) and IAPMO (2018) do not have steel duct construction requirements for single-dwelling units.

For spaces not exceeding 708 m^3 in volume (light commercial), it is recommended that duct systems be Z180 minimum galvanized

Table 6A Galvanized Sheet Thickness

Gage	Thickness, mm		Nominal Mass, kg/m²
	Nominal	Minimum*	
30	0.399	0.319	3.20
28	0.475	0.395	3.81
26	0.551	0.471	4.42
24	0.701	0.601	5.64
22	0.853	0.753	6.86
20	1.066	0.906	8.08
18	1.311	1.181	10.52
16	1.613	1.463	12.96
14	1.994	1.784	16.01
13	2.372	2.162	19.07
12	2.753	2.523	22.12
11	3.132	2.902	25.16
10	3.510	3.280	28.21

*Minimum thickness is based on thickness tolerances of hot-dip galvanized sheets in cut lengths and coils (per ASTM *Standard* A924M). Tolerance is valid for 1220 and 1524 mm wide sheets.

Table 6B Uncoated Steel Sheet Thickness

Gage	Thickness, mm			Nominal Mass, kg/m²
		Minimum*		
	Nominal	Hot-Rolled	Cold-Rolled	
28	0.378		0.328	3.05
26	0.455		0.405	3.66
24	0.667		0.587	4.88
22	0.759		0.679	6.10
20	0.912		0.832	7.32
18	1.214	1.084	1.114	9.76
16	1.519	1.369	1.389	12.20
14	1.897	1.717	1.767	15.25
13	2.278	2.101	2.456	18.31
12	2.656	2.456	2.506	21.35
11	3.038	2.838	2.888	24.40
10	3.416	3.216	3.266	27.45

Note: Table is based on 1220 mm width coil and sheet stock; 1524 mm coil has same tolerance, except that 16 gage is ±0.18 mm in hot-rolled coils and sheets.
*Minimum thickness is based on thickness tolerances of hot-rolled and cold-rolled sheets in cut lengths and coils (per ASTM *Standards* A1008M, A568M, and A1011M).

Table 6C Stainless Steel Sheet Thickness

Gage	Thickness, mm		Nominal Mass, kg/m²	
			Stainless Steel	
	Nominal	Minimum*	300 Series	400 Series
28	0.384	0.334	3.09	3.04
26	0.452	0.372	3.65	3.58
24	0.597	0.517	4.82	4.72
22	0.744	0.644	6.01	5.89
20	0.902	0.802	7.28	7.14
18	1.219	1.089	9.84	9.65
16	1.511	1.361	12.20	11.96
14	1.908	1.728	15.39	15.10
13	2.286	2.056	18.45	18.10
12	2.677	2.447	21.60	21.19
11	3.048	2.798	24.60	24.13
10	3.429	3.129	27.67	27.14

*Minimum thickness is based on thickness tolerances for hot-rolled sheets in cut lengths and cold-rolled sheets in cut lengths and coils (per ASTM *Standard* A480M).

steel, aluminum, or stainless steel in compliance with SMACNA (2020) or flexible duct in compliance with UL 181.

Round, Flat Oval, and Rectangular Ducts

Round Ducts. Round ducts are inherently strong and rigid, and are generally the most efficient and economical ducts for air systems. The dominant factor in round duct construction is the material's ability to withstand the physical abuse of installation and negative pressure requirements. SMACNA (2020) lists construction requirements as a function of static pressure, type of seam (spiral or longitudinal), and stiffeners if required. Proprietary joint systems are available from several manufacturers. *Round Industrial Duct Construction Standards* (SMACNA 2013) provides pressures from 7.5 kPa up to 12.5 kPa.

Flat Oval Ducts. SMACNA (2020) also lists flat oval duct construction requirements. Seams and transverse joints are generally the same as those allowed for round ducts. However, proprietary joint systems are available from several manufacturers. Flat oval positive- and negative-pressure ducts should meet the functional requirements of Section 3.3 of SMACNA (2020). Hanger designs and installation details for rectangular ducts generally also apply to flat oval ducts.

Rectangular Ducts. *HVAC Duct Construction Standards—Metal and Flexible* (SMACNA 2020) lists construction requirements for rectangular steel ducts and includes combinations of duct thicknesses, maximum distance between reinforcements, and support length. Transverse joints (e.g., standing drive slips, pocket locks, and companion angles) and, when necessary, intermediate structural members and tie rods are designed to reinforce the duct system. Proprietary joint systems are available from several manufacturers. *Rectangular Industrial Duct Construction Standards* (SMACNA 2007) provides pressures up to ±37 kPa.

Fittings must be reinforced similarly to sections of straight duct. On size change fittings, the greater fitting dimension determines material thickness. Where fitting curvature or internal member attachments provide equivalent rigidity, such features may be credited as reinforcement.

Nonferrous Ducts. SMACNA (2020) lists construction requirements for rectangular (±750 Pa) and round (±500 Pa) aluminum ducts. *Round Industrial Duct Construction Standards* (SMACNA 2013) gives construction requirements for round aluminum duct systems for pressures up to ±7.5 kPa12.5 kPa.

Fibrous Glass Ducts

Fibrous glass ducts are a composite of rigid fiberglass and a factory-applied facing (typically aluminum or reinforced aluminum), which serves as a finish and vapor retarder. Fibrous glass ducts must be constructed from UL Class 1 air duct material in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions and meet the requirements of UL *Standard* 181 for rigid air ducts. Fibrous glass duct are available in molded round sections or in board form for fabrication into rectangular or polygonal shapes.

Duct systems of round and rectangular fibrous glass are generally limited to 12 m/s and ±500 Pa. Molded round ducts are available in higher pressure ratings. *Fibrous Glass Duct Construction Standards* (NAIMA 2002a; SMACNA 2021) and manufacturers' installation instructions give details on fibrous glass duct construction. SMACNA (2021) also covers duct and fitting fabrication, closure, reinforcement, and installation, including installation of duct-mounted HVAC appurtenances (e.g., volume dampers, turning vanes, register and grille connections, diffuser connections, access doors, fire damper connections, electric heaters). AIA (2006) includes guidelines for using fibrous glass ducts in health care facilities.

Phenolic Ducts

A phenolic duct system comprises phenolic panels, fabrication methods, coupling systems, and accessories to produce preinsulated rectangular ductwork in sections up to 4 m long. Phenolic panels are 22 mm thickness and 30 mm thickness (SMACNA 2015). Phenolic ducts must be UL Class1 and meet the requirements of UL *Standard* 181 for rigid air ducts.

Phenolic panels comprise a fiber-free rigid thermoset phenolic insulation core faced with silver aluminum foil on one side and plain silver aluminum foil on the other. In addition, there are several transverse joint systems available to suit different installation and project specification requirements. They include panel fastener systems, aluminum grip type flange systems, and a four-bolt system.

Technical data for such ducts are necessary to properly design air distribution duct systems. To address that issue, RP-1764 (ASHRAE 2018) measured the relative and absolute roughness of phenolic duct systems connected with a four-bolt flange and cleat joint. An experimental program was conducted to measure the relative and absolute roughness of phenolic duct systems connected with a four-bolt flange and cleat joint. Ducts with seven distinct rectangular cross sections (internal aspect ratios $1 \leq W/H \leq 4$) were investigated. In every instance, the duct material thickness was 22 mm, with smooth aluminum foil covering the internal surface between flanges. For unreinforced phenolic ducts with 3.0 m sections connected by four-bolt flanges, the relative roughness $\varepsilon/\Delta h$ ranged from 0.0002 to 0.0005, with an average value of 0.0003. For similar ducts having 1.5 m duct sections (double the number of flanges per test section), the relative roughness range and average doubled. It appears that the flanges are the dominant effect on relative roughness and that the ducts tested have about 1.5 to 2.8 times more absolute roughness than the average value for galvanized steel ducts described in the *ASHRAE Handbook*. One additional case considered in RP-1764 indicated that the zero-length loss coefficient for an individual internal cross reinforcement $C = 0.080$, assuming that each reinforcement assembly contributed equally to the overall pressure loss in the test section. When compared at the same volume flow rate to unreinforced ducts, the presence of internal cross reinforcements more than doubled the measured pressure loss per unit length, for the specific geometry of reinforcement and duct cross section considered. Note that the resulting loss coefficient applies only to the specific geometry of reinforcement and duct cross section considered in RP-1764, and further investigation is suggested if other types of reinforcement are used.

Flexible Ducts

Flexible ducts are categorized by their UL listing as either **air duct** or **air connector** (see the section on Definitions). Air ducts and air connectors may be metallic or nonmetallic and are listed and labeled as Class 0 or Class 1 by UL *Standard* 181. These ducts must be installed per the conditions of their listing and the manufacturer's installation instructions provided. The maximum allowed temperature inside flexible ducts (air ducts and air connectors) is 121°C per their listing and NFPA 90A and 90B requirements.

Commentary: The IMC (2021), IRC (2021), and UMC (2021) require installation instructions on or within the package or there must be specific directions referring to the manufacturer's web site for instructions. Generally, minimum instructions are provided on or inside the package, with reference to the website for more detailed instructions. Also see the section on Installation.

Flexible Air Connectors. Air connectors are limited-use flexible ducts that can be used in lieu of air ducts in NFPA 90A and 90B buildings provided that they comply with the following limitations:

1. Length does not exceed 4.3 m. Connecting multiple sections of flexible air connectors using sheet metal couplings to obtain a total air connector run greater than that allowed by code is not allowed.
2. The flexible air connector does not pass through any wall, partition, or enclosure of a vertical shaft having a fire resistance rating of 1 hour or more.
3. The flexible air connector does not pass through floors.
4. An air connector shall not be interrupted by a short collar or any other fitting on one side and then connected to another air connector on the other side where penetrating a floor or a wall, partition, or enclosure of a vertical shaft that is required to have a fire-resistance rating of 1 hour.

Commentary:

- Uniform Mechanical Code (UMC 2021) limits flexible air ducts and flexible air connectors to no longer than 1.5 m in length for nonresidential systems and does not allow their use in lieu of rigid elbows or fittings, except when connected to terminal devices.
- In addition to NFPA 90A (2021) and 90B (2021), the International Mechanical Code (IMC 2021) also limits flexible air connectors to 4.3 m in length.

For commercial systems, Chapter 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* recommends flexible ducts be limited to 2 m maximum, fully stretched.

Hangers and Supports

SMACNA (2020) covers HVAC system hangers for rectangular, round, and flat oval ducts. When special analysis is required for larger ducts, loads, or other hanger configurations, AISC and AISI design manuals should be consulted. To hang or support fibrous glass ducts, the methods detailed by NAIMA (2002a) and SMACNA (2021) are recommended.

Flexible air ducts and flexible air connectors should be supported at intervals not exceeding 1.2 m when installed horizontal and 1.8 m when installed as vertical risers. Flexible duct supports should be minimum 38 mm wide and of sufficient rigidity to maintain this width to prevent any restriction of the internal duct diameter when the weight of the supported section rests on the hanger. Cloth hangers should not be used.

Installation

Sheet metal ducts must be installed in accordance with *HVAC Duct Construction Standards—Metal and Flexible* (SMACNA 2020).

Fibrous glass ducts must be installed in accordance with the industry fibrous glass duct construction standards (NAIMA 2002a; SMACNA 2021).

Flexible ducts must be installed in accordance with *Flexible Duct Performance and Installation Standards* (ADC 2021), and as follows:

1. Owner's representative should review flexible duct markings to verify that the flexible duct is (1) a UL listed "Air Duct" or "Air Connector," and (2) installed per applicable code limitations.
2. Flexible air ducts and flexible air connectors should be installed fully extended with minimal compression. Excess length should not be allowed for future relocation of VAV boxes, registers, or other system components.
3. Install flexible ducts so that bends equal or exceed one duct diameter bend radius based on the inside duct diameter. Ducts should not be bent across sharp corners such as pipes, wires, posts, joists, or trusses.

4. For recommended flexible air duct and flexible air connector spacing, refer to the section on Hangers and Supports.
5. The maximum sag between horizontal duct supports should be 42 mm per m.
6. Tape and mastic used for sealing flexible duct to metal fittings should be listed and labeled to UL *Standard* 181B. For details, consult the HVAC System Leakage, Sealants sections "General" and "Flexible Duct."
7. Do not install flexible duct upstream of VAV boxes. Instead, use rigid ducts in these locations as described by Taylor (2015).
8. When installing flexible air ducts and flexible air connectors in inaccessible spaces, the use of metal worm-gear clamps is recommended. Nonmetallic fasteners (plastic straps) are not recommended.
9. Do not penetrate nonmetallic flexible duct inner core with sheet metal screws unless the flexible duct manufacturer's installation instructions specifically allow the use of screws as part of the closure method.
10. When installing flexible air ducts and flexible air connectors in inaccessible spaces, attention should be given to the ability to clean the flexible duct (see the section on Duct Cleaning).
11. For insulated ducts, the outer vapor barrier should be pulled back over the core and fitting and secured using two wraps of UL 181B-FX tape. A clamp may be used in place of or in combination with the tape.
12. Fittings used in combination with flexible air ducts and air connectors should have a 50 mm minimum rigid attaching collar with a bead. Flexible duct inner cores should be installed at least 25 mm onto the fitting and past the bead prior to taping and application of the mechanical fastener past the bead. Beaded fittings are not required when metal worm-gear clamps are used.

Plenums and Apparatus Casings

SMACNA (2020) shows details on field-fabricated plenum and apparatus casings. Sheet metal thickness and reinforcement for plenum and casing pressure outside the range of –750 to +2500 Pa (gage) can be based on *Rectangular Industrial Duct Construction Standards* (SMACNA 2020).

Carefully analyze plenums and apparatus casings on the discharge side of a fan for maximum operating pressure in relation to the construction detail being specified. On the fan's suction side, plenums and apparatus casings are normally constructed to withstand negative air pressure at least equal to the total upstream static pressure loss. Accidentally stopping intake airflow can apply a negative pressure as great as the fan shutoff pressure. Conditions such as malfunctioning dampers or clogged louvers, filters, or coils can collapse a normally adequate casing. To protect large casing walls or roofs from damage, it is more economical to provide fan safety interlocks, such as damper end switches or pressure limit switches, than to use heavier sheet metal construction.

Apparatus casings can perform two acoustical functions. If the fan is completely enclosed within the casing, fan noise transmission through the fan room to adjacent areas is reduced substantially. An acoustically lined casing also reduces airborne noise in connecting ductwork. Acoustical treatment may consist of a single metal wall with a field-applied acoustical liner or thermal insulation, or a double-walled panel with an acoustical liner and a perforated metal inner liner. Double-walled casings are marketed by many manufacturers, who publish data on structural, acoustical, and thermal performance and also prepare custom designs.

Acoustical Treatment

Metal ducts are frequently lined with acoustically absorbent materials to reduce noise. Although many materials are acoustically absorbent, duct liners must also be resistant to erosion and fire and have properties compatible with the ductwork fabrication and erection process. For higher-velocity ducts, double-walled construction using a perforated metal inner liner is frequently specified. Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* addresses design considerations, including external lagging. ASTM *Standard* C423 covers laboratory testing of duct liner materials to determine their sound absorption coefficients, and ASTM *Standard* E477 covers acoustical insertion loss of duct liner materials. Designers should review all the tests in ASTM *Standard* C1071. A wide range of performance attributes (e.g., vapor adsorption and resistance to erosion, temperature, bacteria, and fungi) is covered. Health and safety precautions are addressed, and manufacturers' certifications of compliance are also covered. AIA (2006) includes guidelines for using duct liner in hospital and health care facilities.

Rectangular duct liners should be secured by mechanical fasteners and installed in accordance with *HVAC Duct Construction Standards—Metal and Flexible* (SMACNA 2020). Adhesives should be Type I, in conformance to ASTM *Standard* C916, and should be applied to the duct, with at least 90% coverage of mating surfaces. Good workmanship prevents delamination of the liner and possible blockage of coils, dampers, flow sensors, or terminal devices. Rough edges should be sealed to prevent airborne fibers and erosion of lining. Avoid uneven edge alignment at butted joints to minimize unnecessary resistance to airflow (Swim 1978).

Rectangular metal ducts are susceptible to rumble from flexure in the duct walls during start-up and shutdown. For a system that must switch on and off frequently (for energy conservation) while buildings are occupied, duct construction that reduces objectionable noise should be specified.

7. INDUSTRIAL DUCT CONSTRUCTION

NFPA *Standard* 91 is widely used for design, construction, installation, and maintenance of duct systems conveying particulates and removing flammable vapors (including paint-spraying residue), and corrosive fumes. Industrial duct systems are generally classified as follows:

- **Class 1** covers nonparticulate applications, including makeup air, general ventilation, and gaseous emission control.
- **Class 2** is imposed on moderately abrasive particulate in light concentration, such as that produced by buffing and polishing, woodworking, and grain handling.
- **Class 3** consists of highly abrasive material in low concentration, such as that produced from abrasive cleaning, dryers and kilns, boiler breeching, and sand handling.
- **Class 4** is composed of highly abrasive particulates in high concentration, including materials conveying high concentrations of particulates listed under Class 3.
- **Class 5** covers corrosive applications such as acid fumes.

For contaminant abrasiveness ratings, see SMACNA's (2013, 2007) round or rectangular industrial duct construction standards. See Chapters 15 to 34 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for specific processes and uses.

Materials

Galvanized steel, uncoated carbon steel, or aluminum are most frequently used for industrial air handling. Aluminum ducts are not used for conveying abrasive materials; when temperatures exceed 200°C, galvanized steel is not recommended. Duct material for handling corrosive gases, vapors, or mists must be selected carefully. For the application of metals and use of protective coatings in corrosive environments, consult *Accepted Industry Practice for Industrial Duct Construction* (SMACNA 2008), the *Pollution Engineering Practice Handbook* (Cheremisinoff and Young 1975), and publications of the National Association of Corrosion Engineers (NACE) and ASM International (www.asminternational.org).

Round Ducts

SMACNA (2013) provides information on selecting material thickness and reinforcement members for spiral and nonspiral industrial ducts. Spiral-seam ducts are only for industrial duct Class 1, 2, and 5 applications. The tables in this standard are as follows:

Class (Industrial Duct). *Steel*: Classes 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5. *Aluminum*: Class 1 only. *Stainless steel*: Classes 1 and 5.

Pressure classes for steels and aluminum. –7500 Pa to 12 500 Pa, in increments of 500 Pa.

Duct diameter for steels and aluminum. 100 to 2400 mm, in increments of 50 mm. Equations are provided for calculating construction requirements for diameters over 2400 mm.

Rectangular Ducts

Rectangular Industrial Duct Construction Standards (SMACNA 2007) is available for selecting hot-rolled steel, galvanized steel, or stainless steel thickness and reinforcement members for industrial ducts. The data in this standard give the duct construction for any pressure class and panel width.

The designer selects a combination of panel thickness, reinforcement, and reinforcement member spacing to limit the deflection of the duct panel to a design maximum. Any shape of transverse joint or intermediate reinforcement member that meets the minimum requirement of both section modulus and moment of inertia may be selected. The SMACNA data, which may also be used for designing apparatus casings, limit the combined stress in either the panel or structural member to 165 MPa and the maximum allowable deflection of the reinforcement members to 1/360 of the duct width.

Construction Details

Recommended manuals for other construction details are *Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice* (ACGIH 2019), NFPA *Standard* 91, and *Accepted Industry Practice for Industrial Duct Construction* (SMACNA 2008a). For industrial duct Classes 2, 3, and 4, transverse reinforcing of ducts subject to negative pressure below –750 Pa (gage) should be welded to the duct wall rather than relying on mechanical fasteners to transfer the static load.

Hangers

The *Steel Construction Manual* (AISC 2017) and the *Cold-Formed Steel Design Manual* (AISI 2017) give design information for industrial duct hangers and supports. SMACNA standards for round and rectangular industrial ducts (SMACNA 2007, 2013) and manufacturers' schedules include duct design information for supporting ducts at intervals of up to 10 m.

8. ANTIMICROBIAL-TREATED DUCTS

Antimicrobial-treated ducts are coated (as a precoating or after fabrication) with a substance that inhibits the growth of bacteria, mold, and fungi (including mildew). Antimicrobial-treated galvanized steel, stainless steel, and aluminum ducts can be used when the service temperature of the antimicrobial compound is not exceeded. Prefabricated coatings allow metal to be pressed, drawn, bent, and roll-formed without coating loss. Imperfections in metal ducts, such as spot welds and welded joints, can be repaired with a touch-up paint of the antimicrobial compound.

Fabrics can be made inherently antimicrobial by combining the antimicrobial chemistry into the polymer fibers of the product. Glass fiber duct liners can be made resistant to bacterial and fungal growth using a biocide that protects the airstream surface from microbial growth.

Flexible ducts can be manufactured using antimicrobial-treated film materials on the inside of the inner core. Consult the duct manufacturer's specific information to determine the viability of product performance claims.

All antimicrobial coatings or touch-up paints should be EPA-registered antimicrobial compounds, tested per ASTM *Standard* E84, survive minimum and maximum service temperature limits, and comply with NFPA *Standards* 90A and 90B. Coatings should have flame spread/smoke developed ratings not exceeding 25/50, and meet local building code requirements.

9. DUCT CONSTRUCTION FOR GREASE- AND MOISTURE-LADEN VAPORS

Factory-Built Grease Duct Systems

Manufactured grease duct systems are made in accordance with UL *Standard* 1978 and are UL or ETL listed. These systems are also classified in accordance with UL *Standard* 2221 for clearance to combustibles. Factory-built grease duct systems must be assembled in accordance with manufacturers' recommended instructions but are not required to be welded. Component assembly is by bands/sleeves, and the systems are watertight. The gages for metal ducts used in these systems are considerably lighter than for welded site-fabricated grease ducts, and there may be substantial installation savings because components are assembled with tools instead of welding. System segments classified for clearance to combustibles are typically provided as a metal inner and outer shell, with insulation or an air gap in the annular space.

Site-Built Grease Duct Systems

Installation and construction of ducts for removing smoke or grease-laden vapors from cooking equipment should be in accordance with NFPA *Standard* 96. Kitchen exhaust ducts that conform to NFPA *Standard* 96 must (1) be constructed from carbon steel or stainless steel sheet with a minimum thickness in compliance with NFPA *Standard* 96; (2) have all longitudinal seams and transverse joints continuously welded; and (3) be installed without dips or traps that may collect residues, except where traps with continuous or automatic removal of residue are provided. Test ports should not be installed in grease-rated ductwork, except for temporary measuring test holes, which are sealed by welding before equipment use. Because fires may occur in these systems (producing temperatures in excess of 1100°C), provisions are necessary for expansion in accordance with the following table. Ducts that must have a fire resistance rating are usually encased in materials with appropriate thermal and durability ratings.

Kitchen Exhaust Duct Material	Duct Expansion at 1100°C, mm/m
Carbon steel	15.8
Type 304 stainless steel	19.2
Type 430 stainless steel	10.8

Duct Systems for Moisture-Laden Air

Ducts that convey moisture-laden air must have construction specifications that properly account for corrosion resistance, drainage, and waterproofing of joints and seams. No nationally recognized standards exist for applications in areas such as kitchens, swimming pools, shower rooms, and steam cleaning or washdown chambers. Galvanized steel, stainless steel, aluminum, and plastic materials have been used. Wet and dry cycles increase metal corrosion. Chemical concentrations affect corrosion rate significantly. Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* addresses material selection for corrosive environments. Conventional duct construction standards are frequently modified to require welded or soldered joints, which are generally more reliable and durable than sealant-filled, mechanically locked joints. The number of transverse joints should be minimized, and longitudinal seams should not be located on the bottom of the duct. Risers should drain and horizontal

ducts should pitch in the direction most favorable for moisture control. ACGIH (2019) covers hood design.

10. RIGID PLASTIC DUCTS

The *Thermoplastic Duct (PVC) Construction Manual* (SMACNA 2017) covers thermoplastic (polyvinyl chloride, polyethylene, polypropylene, acrylonitrile butadiene styrene) ducts used in commercial and industrial installations. SMACNA's manual provides comprehensive polyvinyl chloride duct construction details for positive or negative 0.5, 1, 1.5, and 2.5 kPa. NFPA *Standard* 91 provides construction details and application limitations for plastic ducts. Model code agencies publish evaluation reports indicating terms of acceptance of manufactured ducts and other ducts not otherwise covered by industry standards and codes.

Physical properties, manufacture, construction, installation, and methods of testing for fiberglass-reinforced thermosetting plastic (FRP) ducts are described in the *Thermoset FRP Duct Construction Manual* (SMACNA 2017). These ducts are intended for air conveyance in corrosive environments as manufactured by hand lay-up, spray-up, and filament winding fabrication techniques. The term *FRP* also refers to fiber-reinforced plastic (fibers other than glass). Other terms for FRP are reinforced thermoset plastic (RTP) and glass-reinforced plastic (GRP), which is commonly used in Europe and Australia. SMACNA (2017) has construction standards for pressures up to ±7.5 kPa, temperatures up to 80°C, round duct sizes to 2440 mm, and rectangular duct panels widths to 2440 mm.

11. AIR DISPERSION SYSTEMS

Air dispersion systems are designed to both convey and disperse air in the space being conditioned. Diffusion options include linear vents, nozzles, orifices, and porous fabrics. There are three typical cross-sectional shapes: semicircular D-shape, quarter round, and cylindrical (most common). D-shape and quarter round are normally mounted to a surface (wall or ceiling), whereas cylindrical are suspended from the ceiling. The cross-sectional area is based on the interior air velocity.

Typically, these systems are made of fabric, but also include sheet metal or plastic film, including porous and nonporous options. UL *Standard* 2518 is the recognized standard to evaluate fabric air dispersion systems and their materials for safety and building code requirements.

Consult the manufacturer for design criteria for selecting air dispersion type [linear vents, orifices, nozzles, microperforated (porous weave) fabric], fabric (porous or nonporous, color, weight, and construction), suspension options (cable or track options), and installation instructions. In design, consider velocities of 5 to 8 m/s at static pressures of 75 to 250 Pa to ensure proper airflow performance. Excessively turbulent airflow (from metal fittings or fans) or higher inlet velocities can cause fabric fluttering, excessive noise, premature material failure, and poor air dispersion. Fabric airflow restriction devices are available to help balance static pressures, reduce turbulence, reduce abrupt inflation, and balance airflow into branch ducts.

Dispersion Types

Linear Vent Outlets. Air is delivered through linear vents providing linear air flow. This vent typically consists of small openings (6 to 25 mm diameter) set in an array that is long and narrow (Figure 2). Airflow typically ranges from about 8 to 93 L/s per linear metre of vent at 125 Pa and is usually installed far enough away from a surface that it is a free-air jet. These linear vents normally run the length of the product on both sides.

Orifice and Nozzle Outlets. Air is delivered through orifices or nozzles (Figure 3), providing jet-type air distribution. Typical applications are gymnasiums, pools, and manufacturing facilities. Nozzles can direct air perpendicularly away from the surface of the duct. Nozzles allow for changing flow direction, rate, and throw. Nozzles generally have the least entrainment of long-throw outlets. The sizes of orifices and nozzles typically range from 13 to 125 mm diameter.

Porous-Duct-Surface Air Distribution System. Airflow is discharged through a porous weave or microperforated fabric (Figure 4), resulting in air velocities 0.15 to 0.41 m/s at the surface of the fabric duct to minimize mixing between supply and room air. This air distribution system is typically used for food processing, cleanrooms, and laboratories where draft elimination and uniform air distribution are required.

NFPA *Standard* 90A and IMC requirements for fabric air distribution systems are as follows:

1. Install systems in entirely exposed locations.
2. Always operate these systems under positive pressure.
3. Do not allow any system component to pass through or penetrate fire-resistance-rated construction.
4. All systems and components must be listed and labeled in accordance with UL 2518.

12. UNDERGROUND DUCTS

No comprehensive standards exist for underground air duct construction. Coated steel, asbestos cement, plastic, tile, concrete, reinforced fiberglass, and other materials have been used. Under-

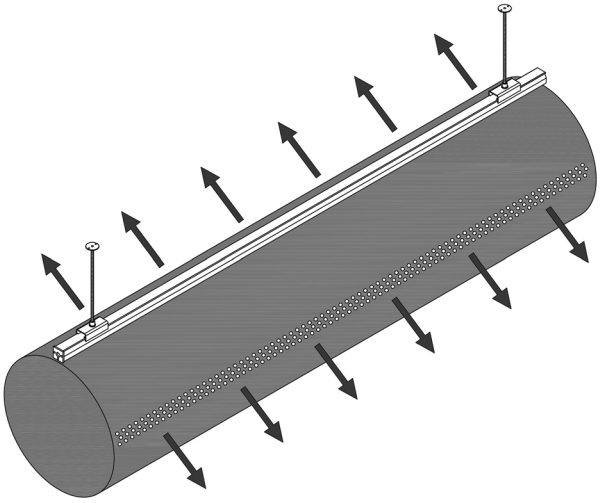

Fig. 2 Fabric Duct with Linear Vent Outlet

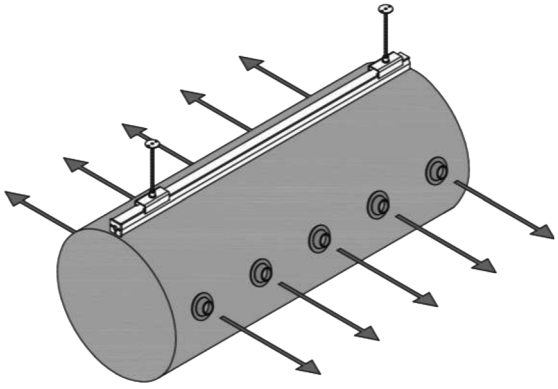

Fig. 3 Fabric Duct with Nozzle Outlets

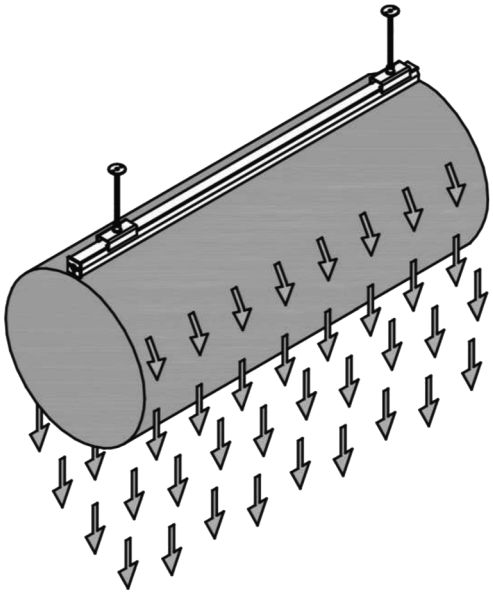

Fig. 4 Fabric Duct with Porous Material as Air Outlet

ground duct and fittings should always be round and have a minimum thickness as listed in SMACNA (2020), although greater thickness may be needed for individual applications. Specifications for construction and installation of underground ducts should account for the following: water tables, ground surface flooding, the need for drainage piping beneath ductwork, temporary or permanent anchorage to resist flotation, frost heave, backfill loading, vehicular traffic load, corrosion, cathodic protection, heat loss or gain, building entry, bacterial organisms, degree of water- and airtightness, inspection or testing before backfill, and code compliance. Chapter 12 has information on cathodic protection of direct-buried conduits. Residential installations may also be subject to the requirements in NFPA *Standard* 90B. Commercial systems also normally require compliance with NFPA *Standard* 90A.

13. DUCTS OUTSIDE BUILDINGS

Exposed ducts and their sealant/joining systems must be evaluated for the following:

- Waterproofing
- Resistance to external loads (wind, snow, and ice)
- Degradation from corrosion, ultraviolet radiation, or thermal cycles
- Heat transfer, solar reflectance, and thermal emittance
- Susceptibility to physical damage
- Hazards at air inlets and discharges
- Maintenance needs

In addition, supports must be custom-designed for rooftop, wall-mounted, and bridge or ground-based applications. Specific requirements must also be met for insulated and uninsulated ducts.

14. SEISMIC QUALIFICATION

Seismic analysis of duct systems may be required by building codes or federal regulations. Provisions for seismic analysis are given by the Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA 2009). Ducts, duct hangers, fans, fan supports, and other duct-mounted equipment are generally evaluated independently. Chapter 56 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* gives design details. SMACNA (2008b) provides guidelines for seismic restraints of mechanical systems and gives bracing details for ducts, pipes, and conduits that apply to the model building codes and ASCE *Standard* 7. FEMA (2013a, 2013b, 2014) has three fully illustrated guides that show equipment installers how to attach mechanical and electrical equipment or ducts and pipes to a building to minimize earthquake damage.

15. SHEET METAL WELDING

AWS (2018) covers sheet metal arc welding and braze welding procedures. It also addresses the qualification of welders and welding operators, workmanship, and the inspection of production welds.

16. THERMAL INSULATION

Insulation materials for ducts, plenums, and apparatus casings are covered in Chapter 23 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Codes generally limit factory-insulated ducts to UL *Standard* 181, Class 0 or 1. *North American Commercial & Industrial Insulation Standards*, 9th ed. (MICA 2022) gives insulation details. ASTM *Standard* C1290 gives specifications for flexible fibrous glass blanket external insulation for ducts.

17. SPECIFICATIONS

Master specifications for duct construction and most other elements in building construction are produced and regularly updated by several organizations. Two examples are *MASTERSPEC* by the American Institute of Architects (AIA) and *SPECTEXT*® by the Construction Sciences Research Foundation (CSRF). *MasterFormat*™ (CSI 2014) is the organization standard for specifications. These documents are model project specifications that require editing to customize each application for a project. It is the design engineer's responsibility to create clear construction specifications.

REFERENCES

ASHRAE members can access *ASHRAE Journal* articles and ASHRAE research project final reports at technologyportal.ashrae.org. Articles and reports are also available for purchase by nonmembers in the online ASHRAE Bookstore at www.ashrae.org/bookstore.

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CHAPTER 20

ROOM AIR DISTRIBUTION EQUIPMENT

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MECHANICAL equipment and their control devices that affect air movement to and within spaces are collectively named **room air distribution equipment.** In addition to providing thermal comfort, acceptable indoor air quality is often achieved through air delivered and removed by this air distribution equipment. Supply air outlets, terminal units, chilled-beam units, in-room or plenum-mounted fan-coil units, air curtain units, and textile air dispersion products introduce air into conditioned spaces to obtain these desired indoor atmospheric environments. Return and exhaust air and airborne contaminants are removed from spaces through return and exhaust inlets (*inlet* and *outlet* are defined relative to the duct system and not the room, as shown in Figure 1). This chapter describes this equipment, details its proper use, and is intended to help HVAC designers select appropriate room air distribution equipment. Air distribution methods needed to properly specify this equipment are outlined in Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, and air diffusion principles are presented in Chapter 20 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals.*

1. SYSTEMS OVERVIEW

This chapter describes outlets, terminal units, and cooling/heating delivery systems commonly used for effective room air distribution. An air distribution system is often used to provide adequate ventilation air, sensible space heating and cooling, and latent heating (humidification) and cooling (dehumidification) to provide comfortable and healthy indoor environments for occupants. All, some, or none of the conditioning of the delivered supply air is done within the room air distribution equipment, depending on the selected HVAC system types.

HVAC systems described in this chapter can be defined as either all-air or air-water (i.e., decoupled) systems. **Decoupled systems** that provide cooling can be further classified by whether they are intended to supplement both sensible and latent cooling or just sensible cooling; with the latter, the cooling coils included in the room air distribution equipment are intended to remain dry. Almost always, the equipment introduced in this chapter is intended to be installed indoors, protected from the weather. The exteriors of the nontextile devices are typically all or mostly galvanized steel or painted metal.

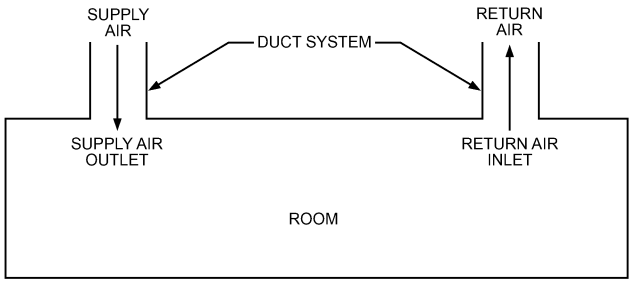

Fig. 1 Designations for Inlet and Outlet

All-Air Systems

All-air systems rely on conditioned air, delivered from central air-handling units via supply air ducts, to fulfill all of the space ventilation, heating, and cooling needs of the spaces. Zone airflow control devices such as dampers and fans often modulate the zone airflow delivery in response to the spaces' cooling and heating demands. Although zone-level reheat coils may be used to heat the air before its delivery, spaces' cooling and ventilation is provided by the air-handling units in all-air systems. Variable-air-volume (VAV, with constant or varying supply air temperature) systems are the prime example of all-air systems, although all-air systems can be constant air volume (CAV, with variable supply air temperature or on/off control).

Decoupled Systems

Decoupled systems' zone-level terminal units rely on receiving adequately preconditioned ventilation air from their air-handling unit, but typically the terminal units provide supplemental space sensible and latent cooling. The terminal units may also be specified with heating or reheating capacity. The decoupled cooling/dehumidification may be provided by either chilled-water or refrigerant coils within the zone terminal units, and the heating by hot-water, steam, heat pump, or electric-resistance coils. Terminal units' refrigerant-based coils, such as used in heat pump and variable-refrigerant-flow (VRF) systems, are not addressed in this chapter.

Sensible-Only Decoupled Systems

Decoupled sensible systems use the air-handling unit to provide fully conditioned ventilation air and all its zones' latent cooling requirements while the zones' terminal units provide most or all of the zones' sensible cooling. Heating capacity may or may not be provided in the terminal units. The terminal units' cooling coils use chilled water supplied at or above the space dew-point temperature to prevent condensation from occurring. The zone's sensible heat is removed from secondary air as it passes through the sensible cooling coil. Examples of decoupled sensible cooling systems include chilled beams and sensible cooling fan-powered chilled-water terminals; these are discussed further in this chapter.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 5.3, Room Air Distribution.

2. SYSTEM CLASSIFICATIONS

Room air distribution systems can be classified according to their primary objective and the method used to accomplish that objective. The objective of any air distribution system is to condition and/or ventilate the space for its occupants, to support processes within the space, or both.

Methods used to condition spaces can be classified as

- **Fully mixed** systems intend to produce uniform temperature and pollutant concentration with little or no stratification within the occupied and/or process space. Overhead air distribution, with both supply and return/exhaust above occupants or processes, is an example of this type of system.
- **Fully stratified** systems intend little mixing of air within the occupied and/or process space. Displacement ventilation, where the room air moves in a plug- or piston- type motion, is an example of this type of system.
- **Partially mixed** systems provide some mixing of air in the occupied and/or process space while creating stratified conditions in the volume above. Most underfloor air distribution designs (UFAD) are examples of this type of system.
- **Task/ambient** air distribution focuses on conditioning only a portion of the space for thermal comfort and/or process control. Examples of task/ambient systems are personally controlled desk outlets and spot-conditioning systems. Because task/ambient distribution requires a high level of individual control, it is not covered in this chapter, but is discussed in Chapter 20 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Additional design guidance is also provided in Bauman (2003).

Figure 2 illustrates the spectrum between the two extremes (fully mixed and fully stratified) of room air distribution strategies.

Review the following publications when selecting systems and equipment for room air distribution:

- ANSI/ASHRAE *Standard* 55 establishes indoor thermal environmental and personal factors for the occupied space.
- ANSI/ASHRAE *Standards* 62.1 and 62.2 specify ventilation requirements for acceptable indoor air quality. These standards are adopted as part of many building codes.
- ANSI/ASHRAE/IES *Standards* 90.1 and 90.2 provide minimum energy efficiency requirements that affect supply air characteristics in various types of buildings in low-rise and non-low-rise buildings.

Local codes should also be checked for applicability to each of these subjects.

Other useful references on selecting air distribution equipment include AMCA *Standard* 222, Chapter 20 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, ASHRAE's (2013) *UFAD Guide: Design, Construction and Operation of Underfloor Air Distribution Systems*, Chen and Glicksman (2003), Rock and Zhu (2002), Skistad (2002), and ASHRAE/REHVA's *Active and Passive Beam Application Design Guide* (Woollett and Rimmer 2014).

2.1 FULLY MIXED SYSTEMS

In fully mixed systems, supply air outlets, properly sized and located, establish then control the air pattern in a room to obtain proper air mixing and temperature equalization.

Supply airflow from an outlet (**primary air**) entrains room air into the outlet's jet or jets. This entrained air (**secondary air**) increases the combined air (**total air**) in the jet as it proceeds farther from the outlet. The momentum of the primary jet remains constant, so the jet's velocity decreases as the mass increases. As the two air masses mix, the temperature of the jet from a properly selected, installed, and operated outlet approaches the room air temperature (Rock and Zhu 2002). Outlets should be sized to project air so that its velocity and temperature reach acceptable levels before entering the occupied zone of a space, often defined as the lowest 1.8 m of a room. **Throw** is the distance from the origin of the jet to the point where the velocity of the total air is reduced to a desired value.

Outlet locations and patterns also affect a jet's throw, entrainment, and temperature equalization capabilities. Some general characteristics include the following:

- When outlets are located close to a surface such as a ceiling, entrainment may be restricted, which can result in a longer throw.
- When the air pattern is spread horizontally in multiple directions, throw is reduced.
- Outlets with horizontally radial airflow patterns (e.g., from a round diffuser) typically have shorter throws than outlets with directional patterns.
- An outlet cannot discharge air properly and uniformly unless the air enters it in a straight and uniform manner.

Ceiling or sidewall outlets in cooling applications are often selected with supply air temperatures at or above 11°C. Special high-induction outlets are available for use with low-temperature

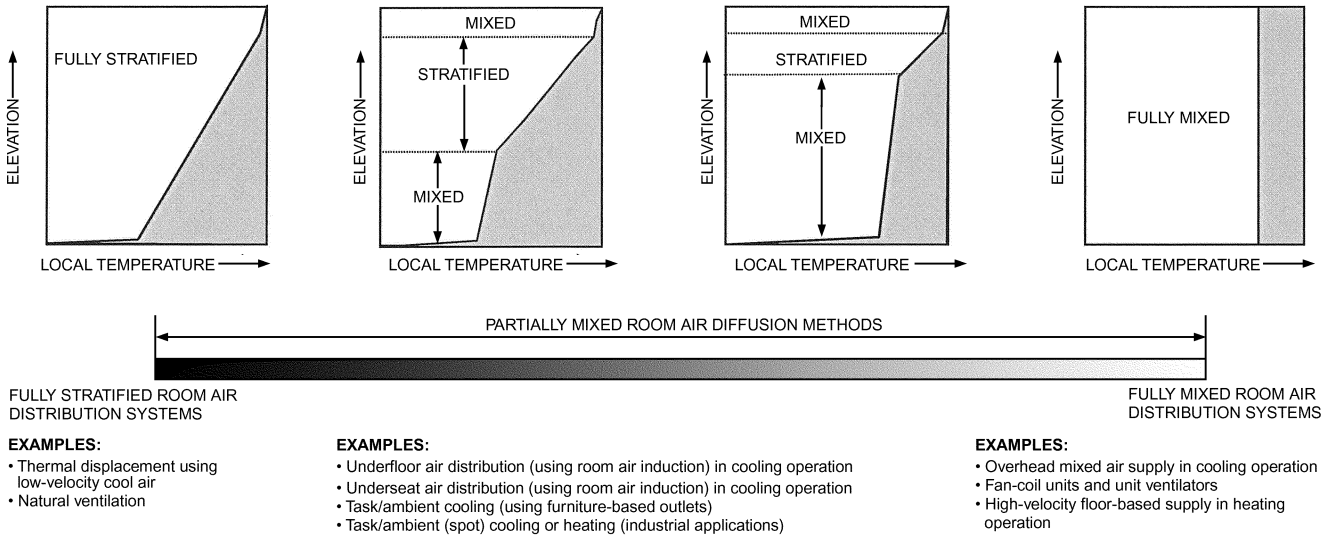

Fig. 2 Classification of Air Distribution Strategies

air distribution systems (i.e., those with supply air temperature below 11°C). These outlets include special features and rapidly mix cold supply air with room air at the outlet and effectively reduce the temperature differential between the supply and room air. For further information, designers can consult ASHRAE's (1996) *Cold Air Distribution System Design Guide*.

Accessories used with an outlet can regulate the volumetric flowrate of supply air and control its flow pattern. Accessories may also be necessary for proper air distribution in a space, so they must be selected and used according to the manufacturers' recommendations.

Factors That Influence Selection

Coanda (Surface or Ceiling) Effect. Via restricting secondary air entrainment, a jet moving adjacent to or in contact with an impermeable wall or ceiling creates a low-pressure area immediately adjacent to that surface, causing the air to remain in contact with the surface substantially throughout the length of throw. This **Coanda effect**, also referred to as the **surface** or **ceiling effect**, counteracts, to varying extents, the negative-buoyancy-driven the drop of a horizontally projected cool airstream.

Round and four-way horizontal-throw ceiling outlets exhibit a high Coanda effect because the discharge air pattern blankets the ceiling area surrounding each outlet. This effect diminishes with a directional discharge that does not blanket the full ceiling surface surrounding the outlet due to entrainment into the exposed sides of the jet. Sidewall outlets exhibit varying degrees of Coanda effect, depending on the spread of the particular air pattern, the angle of the jet, and the distance from the outlet's discharge to the surface.

When outlets are mounted such that they discharge into a free space not near an adjacent surface (e.g., exposed duct-mounted supply air grille applications), the airstream entrains air around the entire perimeter of the jet. As a result, the rate of entrainment is higher and the throw is shortened. More information on jet behavior can be found in Chapter 20 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Temperature Differential. The greater the temperature differential between the supply air projected into a space and the air in the space, the greater the buoyancy effect on the path of the supply airstream. Heated, horizontally projected air rises and cooled air falls, so this effect should be considered during outlet selection. Chapter 20 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* has further discussion of the buoyancy effect.

Low-temperature supply air or cold building start-up in a humid environment may cause condensation. Consider the effect of condensation on outlet and space surfaces during outlet selection.

Sound Level. The sound level from an outlet is largely a function of its discharge velocity and transmission of HVAC system noise, such as from fans and air turbulence, and may be desirable for masking other sounds, or, if too high, may be considered noise by occupants. For a given air capacity, a larger outlet face area has a lower discharge velocity and correspondingly lower generated sound. However, a larger outlet also allows more system-generated sound to pass through the outlet, which may appear as outlet-generated noise to occupants. High-frequency noise can result from excessive outlet velocity but may also be generated in the duct by the moving airstream. Low-frequency noise is usually generated by mechanical equipment and transmitted through the duct and outlet to the room.

The cause of a noise complaint can usually be pinpointed as outlet or system sounds by removing the outlet's core during operation. If the noise remains essentially unchanged, the system is the source. If the noise is significantly reduced, the outlet is likely the source. The noise may be caused by a highly irregular velocity profile at the entrance to the outlet. ASHRAE research project RP-1335 (Landsberger 2011) and Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* have more details on the effects of inlet conditions on air outlets.

Variable-Air-Volume (VAV) Outlet. A VAV outlet is an air outlet that self-modulates its primary air flow rate with an integral air damper. Select outlets based on the total range of airflow needed for the space served. Outlet performance characteristics should be evaluated at both minimum and maximum flow. More information regarding selection of outlets can be found in Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Outlet Selection Procedure

The following procedure is generally used in selecting and locating an outlet in a fully mixed system. More details and examples are available in Rock and Zhu (2002) and Chapter 58 of the 2019 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

1. Determine the design flow rates of air to be supplied to each room. (See Chapters 17 and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* to determine air quantities for heating and cooling modes.)
2. Select the type and quantity of outlets for each room, considering factors such as air quantity required, distance available for throw or radius of diffusion, structural characteristics, and architectural concepts.
3. Outlets may be sized and located to distribute air in the space to achieve acceptable temperature and velocity in the occupied zone. Select and locate outlets such that the air supplied reaches the breathing zone, as defined by ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 for heating and cooling in many buildings.
4. Select the proper size outlet from the manufacturers' performance data according to air quantity, neck and discharge velocity, throw, distribution pattern, and sound level. Note manufacturers' recommendations regarding use. Also, obstructions to the primary air distribution pattern require special study. In an open space, the interaction of airstreams from multiple air outlets may alter a single outlet's throw, air temperature, or air velocity. As a result, manufacturers' data may be insufficient to predict air motion in a particular space. The **air diffusion performance index (ADPI)** is a useful tool in predicting outlet performance for fully mixed systems; see Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information.

2.2 FULLY STRATIFIED SYSTEMS

Stratified room air distribution systems, typically called **thermal displacement ventilation**, generally rely on supply outlets with very low discharge velocities (e.g., 0.2 to 0.36 m/s based on total face area) to produce minimal room air entrainment so that much of the temperature difference between supply and the occupied zone's air is preserved. With outlets placed low, and when in cooling mode, cool supply air accumulates near the floor. Heat sources in the occupied zone create convection plumes that originate around the boundaries of the heat source and rise naturally because of their buoyancy. If these sources are near the supply airstream, supply air is entrained to fill the void of the rising convection plume.

The cooling-mode temperature differential between supply and room air is generally less than that commonly used for fully mixed systems. Exhaust air is generally higher temperature compared to fully mixed systems, especially with high ceilings. Stratified systems used in transient spaces where thermal comfort is less critical may, however, use air temperature differentials like those in fully mixed systems.

Factors that Influence Selection

Space Considerations. To maximize system efficiency, supply outlets are typically located below the occupant breathing level, so

installed low in the sidewall or in-floor. These supply outlets often take up considerably more surface area than outlets used in fully mixed systems. Wall recessed outlets are common but can be configured as quarter-round, semicircular, rectangular, or cylindrical to increase face area. Cylindrical air outlets are generally mounted in a room's open space, whereas the other configurations are mounted in corners, adjacent to the side wall, or flush with the wall.

Space Heating Considerations. Skistad (2002) reported that displacement ventilation can be combined successfully with radiators and convectors at exterior walls to offset space heat losses. Radiant heating panels and heated floors also can be used with displacement ventilation. When a secondary heating system is used, displacement outlets should supply air at least 1 K cooler than room temperature to maintain displacement airflow to the space.

System and Terminal Considerations. Low-velocity supply air outlets used in fully stratified systems can function properly with either constant- or variable-air-volume (CAV or VAV) supply air systems. For VAV applications, the supply air flow rate should be varied via a thermostat located in the space at a height of 1.2 to 1.5 m.

For fully stratified systems in humid climates, using series fan-powered terminal units or other mixing zone devices may allow supply air to be delivered from the central HVAC system at conventional temperatures and then blended with return/plenum air in the terminal unit to bring the air to an appropriate discharge temperature. However, this may compromise the space contaminant removal benefits of the displacement system.

Outlet Selection Procedure

Supply outlets used in stratified air systems tend to be mounted low in the sidewall or in-floor. They may also be mounted in the floor or risers beneath seats in public assembly facilities. Both mounting locations can produce adequately low discharge velocities; however, the outlets needed tend to be quite large. Because discharge velocities are very low, the supply airstream produces little momentum, and small obstacles, other than heat sources, in the flow path have little effect on its travel. Selection and application of air outlets for these systems is based primarily on the following considerations:

- Maintaining **vertical temperature gradients** within the occupied zone that conform to ASHRAE *Standard* 55. Further guidance on designing for conformance to this standard is presented in Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.
- Maintaining a **clear zone** (also called **adjacent zone**) to the outlets that is acceptable to the function and occupancy of the space.
- Providing **acoustical performance** that conforms to the requirements of the space.

Supply outlets used in fully stratified systems are typically selected for a maximum face velocity of 0.2 to 0.36 m/s. Limitation of the face velocity is determined by noise requirements and proximity of occupants to the outlet. Where space noise requirements are not so stringent and stationary occupants are far away from diffusers, higher face velocities can be used. It is also important that the supply air outlet and its ductwork be designed to distribute airflow evenly across the outlet's entire discharge area to avoid excessive velocity deviations.

The area adjacent to the supply outlet where local velocities may exceed 0.25 m/s is defined as the adjacent zone, where local velocity/temperatures may combine to create drafty conditions. Manufacturers of outlets specifically intended for fully stratified systems publish predicted adjacent-zone values that depend on the outlet supply airflow rate and the initial temperature difference between the supply and room air. Stationary occupants should not be present routinely in the adjacent zone.

For applications requiring very low noise criteria, such as broadcast or recording studios or performing arts venues, acoustical performance is an important consideration. Because of their low-velocity discharge, these supply outlets can generally be selected to meet acoustical criteria for these applications.

2.3 PARTIALLY MIXED SYSTEMS

Partially mixed room air distribution systems are those whose design intent is to create mixed conditions in a portion of the room while maintaining thermal stratification in the remainder of the space. Supply outlets for these systems are usually designed and selected to discharge supply air from low sidewall or floor locations. These outlets produce high room air entrainment such that velocity and temperature differentials between supply and room air can be quickly dissipated. This results in relatively well-mixed room air conditions in some or all the occupied space, while stratified conditions are maintained throughout the remainder. Although most underfloor air distribution systems should be classified as partially mixed systems, underfloor air delivery can also produce fully mixed or fully stratified room air distribution.

Because supply air is introduced in the occupied zone, the supply air temperature is generally set above 16.7°C for cooling mode.

Factors That Influence Selection

Space Considerations. Partially mixed air distribution systems often rely on a pressurized plenum to deliver conditioned air to the supply air outlets; therefore, most of these outlets are not individually ducted. For example, underfloor air distribution systems commonly use the cavity beneath a raised access floor as a pressurized plenum. The supply outlets are mounted in the access floor tiles and can easily be relocated in response to space changes and workstation relocation.

Most supply outlets used in pressurized floor plenum applications can be easily adjusted for airflow by the space occupant. In such applications, it is usually effective to provide an adjustable outlet in every office or workstation to afford occupants control of their own environment. Many of these outlets can also be fitted with a thermostatically controlled damper that provides variable air flow rates to the space.

System and Terminal Considerations. Supply air outlets designed specifically for partially mixed room air distribution systems can use either CAV or VAV systems. For VAV applications, the supply air flow rates should be determined via a thermostat located in the space at a height of 1.2 to 1.5 m.

Outlet Selection Procedures

Supply outlets used in stratified air systems tend to be mounted low in the sidewall or in-floor. Because of their high degree of mixing supply and room air together, these outlets can be selected for much higher discharge velocities than those used in fully stratified systems, resulting in significantly smaller outlet discharge areas. Selection and application of air outlets for partially mixed systems is based primarily on the following considerations:

- Maintaining **vertical temperature gradients** in the occupied zone that conform to ASHRAE *Standard* 55. Further guidance on designing for conformance to this standard is presented in Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.
- Maintaining an **adjacent zone** adjoining the outlets that is acceptable to the function and occupancy of the space.
- Providing **acoustical performance** that conforms to the requirements of the space.

Supply outlets should be selected such that their vertical projection achieves comfort and ventilation objectives. Limiting the vertical projection to a terminal velocity of 0.25 m/s of the supply air to below the respiration level, typically 1.4 m per ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1, allows convective heat plume formation around occupants to convey respiratory contaminants up and out of the occupied zone.

This creates breathing-level CO_2 concentrations like those associated with fully stratified room air distribution systems. Projections that exceed this level discourage formation of such plumes and result in space ventilation like that of fully mixed systems.

The area adjacent to the supply outlet where local velocities may exceed 0.25 m/s is defined as the **adjacent zone**, where local velocity/temperatures may combine to create drafty conditions. Manufacturers of outlets specifically intended for fully stratified systems publish predicted adjacent-zone values that depend on the outlet supply airflow rate and the initial temperature difference between the supply and room air. Stationary occupants should not be present routinely in the clear zone.

For applications requiring very low noise criteria, such as broadcast or recording studios or performing arts venues, acoustical performance is an important consideration. These supply outlets may be suitable to meet acoustical criteria for these applications.

3. EQUIPMENT

3.1 SUPPLY AIR OUTLETS

Typically, supply air grilles are used in high sidewall, sill, or floor applications, where supply air diffusers are most commonly used in ceilings or are mounted on exposed overhead ducts. Nozzles are typically installed on high-sidewall locations in large spaces.

High Sidewall. An adjustable double-deflection grille usually provides the most satisfactory solution. The vertical blades of the grille can be set for approximately 50° maximum deflection to either side, which can usually cover the conditioned space. Horizontal blades, if any, can be set to control the elevation of the discharge pattern. Upward deflection minimizes thermal drop in cooling applications, especially when the air jet can then attach to the ceiling.

Ceiling. Such installation is generally limited to ceiling diffusers or grilles with curved vanes that discharge parallel to the mounting surface. For high mounting locations (greater than 3 m above the occupied zone), vertically down discharge outlets may be preferred for these high bay applications. Supply outlets installed in 2.4 to 3 m high ceilings can achieve satisfactory performance if appropriate consideration is made for terminal velocities and temperature differentials in the occupied space. Discharging the airstream directly into occupied zone may result in unacceptable comfort conditions. Supply outlets needed for both heating and cooling from the same device should be carefully examined for use in both modes.

Sill. Linear bar grilles are commonly used in sill applications. The grille should be installed with the supply air jet directed vertically and away from the occupied space. When the device is mounted 300 mm or less from the wall, a device with 0° deflection is suitable. If the device is installed more than 300 mm from the vertical surface, a linear bar grille with a fixed 15 to 30° deflection is recommended. This device should be installed with the jet directed toward the wall. These grilles can be available with doors, removable cores, or other means of access to mechanical equipment that may be installed in the sill enclosure. The presence of window draperies or blinds and the effect of an impinging airstream must be considered in the selection. In high-humidity applications in cold locations, such as a natatorium in winter, special care is needed to prevent condensation on the glazing and other cold exterior surfaces.

Floor. Linear bar grilles are often used for floor applications. The designer should determine the traffic and floor loading on the grille; consult local building code for minimum rating requirements and determine the manufacturer's load limit for the grille. The grille should be placed in low-traffic areas. A floor-mounted grille is usually selected to discharge supply air along a wall or exterior surface. Install with the supply air jet directed vertically and away from the occupied space. When the device is mounted 300 mm or less from the wall, a device with 0° deflection is suitable. If the device is installed more than 300 mm from the vertical surface, a linear bar grille with a fixed 15 to 30° deflection is recommended. This device should be installed with the jet directed toward the wall. The presence of window draperies or blinds and the effect of an impinging airstream must be considered in the selection. Table 1 shows the types of supply air outlets and provides guidance for best use practices. This table is for guidance only; designers should consult manufacturers' literature for additional application information.

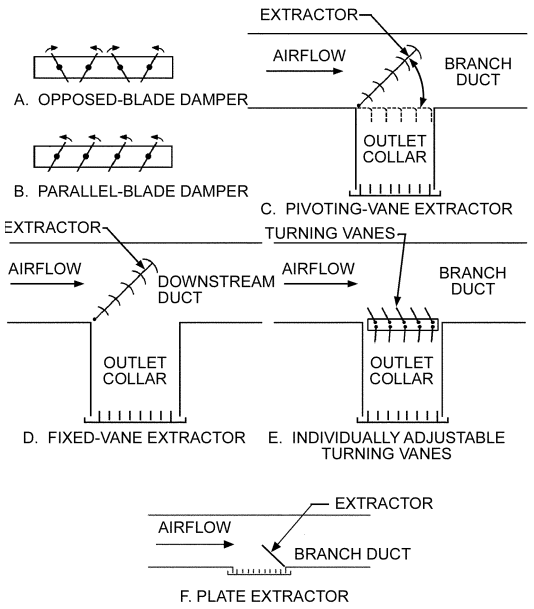

Fig. 3 Accessories for Supply Air Grilles

Underfloor air distribution (UFAD) typically employs swirl or linear bar grille type supply outlets recessed into the floor that discharge directly into the occupied zone. Displacement ventilation typically employs supply outlets fixed to the wall, sometimes mounted in the ceiling or floor, that discharge directly into the occupied zone. When sizing and locating the outlets, care should be taken to ensure occupant thermal comfort with either type.

3.2 RETURN AND EXHAUST AIR INLETS

Return air inlets may either be connected to a return duct or simply cover openings that transfer air from one area to another; the latter are commonly called **transfer grilles**. Exhaust air inlets remove air from a building and, therefore, are almost always connected to an exhaust duct and usually a dedicated fan. Velocity, sound, and pressure requirements for return and exhaust inlets are determined by size and configuration. In general, the same type of equipment, such as grilles, slot diffusers, and ceiling diffusers used for supplying air, may also be used for air return and exhaust. However, return/exhaust inlets do not require the flow deflection, equalizing, and turning devices necessary for supply outlets; their blades may be deflected for blocking lines of sight into ducts, if desired. Return and exhaust inlets may be mounted in practically any location (e.g., ceilings, high or low sidewalls, floors, and doors, the latter if fire code allows). Dampers such as the one shown in Figure 3A are sometimes used in conjunction with return and exhaust grilles to aid system balancing. When used in a partially mixed or fully stratified

Table 1 Typical Applications for Supply Air Outlets

	Fully Mixed			Fully Stratified		Partially Mixed		
Outlet Types	**Ceiling Mounted**	**Wall Mounted**	**Floor/Sill**	**Wall Mounted**	**Floor/Sill**	**Ceiling Mounted**	**Wall Mounted**	**Floor/Sill**
Grilles								
Adjustable blade		●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊙	⊙
Fixed blade	⊙	◘	⊗	◘	⊙	⊗	⊙	⊗
Linear bar	⊗	●	●	◘	◘	⊗	⊙	●
Nozzle and drum louver	◘	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗
Diffusers								
Round	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗
Square	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗
Perforated face	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗
Louvered face	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗
Plaque face	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗
Hemispherical	◘	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	◘	⊗	⊗
Laminar flow	◘	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	◘	⊗	⊗
Linear slot	●	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗
T-bar slot	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗
Light troffer	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗	⊗
Swirl	●	⊗	⊗	⊗	◘	⊗	⊙	●
Displacement	⊗	⊗	⊗	●	●	◘	⊗	⊗
Air dispersion duct	●	◘	⊗	⊗	⊗	◘	◘	⊗

● = often used ◘ = sometimes used ⊙ = seldom used ⊗ = not recommended

system, the returns and exhaust outlets should be located above the occupied zone, either ceiling or high sidewall mounted unless superseded by other codes or standards.

3.3 GRILLES

A supply air grille usually consists of a frame enclosing a set of either fixed or adjustable vertical or horizontal vanes for a single-deflection grille, or both for a double-deflection grille. These are typically used in sidewall, ceiling, sill, and floor applications. Return and exhaust grilles usually have fixed vanes. Pressure drop and acoustic performance are optimized when blades are not angled, though blades may often be adjusted to achieve a desired throw pattern from supply grilles.

Types

Adjustable-Blade Grilles. This is the most common type used as a supply outlet. A single-deflection grille includes a set of either vertical or horizontal vanes or blades. Vertical vanes deflect the airstream in the horizontal plane; horizontal vanes deflect the airstream in the vertical plane. A double-deflection grille has a second set of vanes, typically installed behind and at right angles to the face vanes and controls the airstream in both horizontal and vertical planes.

Fixed-Blade Grilles. These are like the adjustable-blade grille except that the vanes or blades are not adjustable and may be straight or angled. For supply grilles, the angle(s) at which air is discharged depends on the deflection of the vanes. Fixed-blade grilles are more commonly used as return or exhaust air inlets. Angled blades reduce visibility into the ductwork.

Linear Bar Grilles. When used for supply, these outlets typically have fixed bars at the face. The bars normally run parallel to the length of the outlet and may be straight or angled. These devices supply air in a constant direction and are usually attached to a separate supply air plenum that has its own inlet. Linear bar grilles can be installed in multiple sections to achieve long, continuous lengths or installed as a discrete length. Also commonly used in underfloor air distribution systems, some linear bar grilles allow the discharge pattern to be changed using removable or adjustable cores. Many also incorporate a damper and actuator for automatic control of the supply air flow rate via a space thermostat. Linear bar grilles are sometimes manufactured with curved shapes for architectural purposes. When linear bar grilles are used for supply, similar grilles are also commonly used as return or exhaust inlets to provide a consistent architectural appearance.

Eggcrate Grilles. These fixed-blade grilles are only recommended for return or exhaust applications and typically have large free areas exceeding 90% of the face.

Transfer Grilles. These fixed-blade grilles are installed in an interior wall or door allowing air transfer from an enclosed room to an adjacent room or plenum to allow normalization of pressure between them.

Application-Specific Grilles

Security Grilles. Various fixed-blade grille types are available for high-security applications. Security grilles are available with additional features like heavy-duty construction, suicide deterrents, lattice faces, and tamperproof, nonremovable blade designs. Institutional guidelines exist for proper selection and placement of security grilles.

Heavy-Duty Grilles. Robust, heavy-duty designs are available for applications that require greater durability (e.g., industrial, gymnasium, institutional).

Spiral Duct Grilles. Grilles manufactured with a frame designed to be mounted directly onto the surface of a round duct without requiring an additional duct boot.

3.4 NOZZLES AND DRUM LOUVERS

Ball, jet, and adjustable nozzles and drum louvers direct high velocity air jets into the space. These devices typically have long throws and no or few vanes in their airflow paths. They are often installed in buildings as horizontally discharging high-sidewall outlets, in duct soffits (**fur-downs**) or in ductwork. Nozzles and drum louvers are typically used in large spaces. Aircraft and automobile ventilation systems also use smaller versions of these types of outlets (Rock and Zhu 2002).

The equations in Chapter 20 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* can be used to estimate throw from many such simple duct terminations or orifices. For complex situations, physical experiments, or computational fluid dynamics (CFD) modeling, may be helpful in selection and design.

3.5 DIFFUSERS

Diffusers usually generate a radial or directional discharge pattern. For ceiling applications, this pattern is typically parallel to the mounting surface, thus creating a horizontal pattern. Diffusers may also include adjustable deflectors that allow discharge to be directed perpendicular to the mounting surface, creating a vertical pattern. A diffuser typically consists of an outer shell, which contains a duct collar, and internal deflector(s), which define the diffuser's performance, including discharge pattern and direction. Refer to the ASHRAE Handbook Online version of this chapter for illustrations of each diffuser.

Types

Round Diffuser. This diffuser is a series of concentric conical rings flush with the ceiling plane or with dropped inner cones, typically installed either in gypsum-board ceilings or on exposed ducts. Round ceiling diffusers are available in a broad range of sizes and capacities, and with or without adjustable inner cones that allow the diffuser to discharge air either horizontally or vertically.

Square Diffuser. This diffuser consists of concentric square, drawn louvers that radiate from the center of the diffuser. They are commonly mounted in suspended or gypsum-board ceilings or are attached to exposed ducts. Their necks can be round or rectangular, and the necks' sizes should be matched to the ducts'. Available with faces that are flush with the ceiling plane or with dropped inner cones, these diffusers have a fixed horizontal radial discharge pattern or an adjustable discharge pattern that allows the direction to be either horizontal or vertical. Special borders can be selected to accommodate various mounting applications; for example, pans are available so that a desired face size can be smaller than a suspended ceiling's grid size.

Perforated Diffuser. This diffuser consists of a duct collar and a single perforated plate that forms the diffuser's face, with typical free area of about 50%. The perforated face tends to create a slightly higher pressure drop and sound than similarly sized square ceiling diffusers. They are available with deflection devices mounted at the neck or on the face plate. The deflectors may be adjustable, to provide horizontal air discharge in one, two, three, or four directions. Special borders can be selected to accommodate various mounting applications.

Louvered-Face Diffuser. This diffuser consists of an outer border, which includes an integral duct collar, and a series of louvers or curved blades. Louvered-face diffusers typically provide a horizontal discharge perpendicular to the louver length. The louvers may be arranged to provide four-way, three-way, two-way opposite, two-way corner, or one-way discharge. Some louvered-face diffusers are available with adjustable louvers that can change the discharge pattern. Special borders are available to accommodate various mounting applications.

Plaque-Face Diffuser. This diffuser is constructed with a duct collar and a single plaque that forms the diffuser's face. This air outlet typically has a horizontal, radial discharge pattern. Special borders can be selected to accommodate various mounting applications.

Hemispherical Flow Diffuser. This diffuser provides a vertically radial air discharge pattern. The discharge penetrates the conditioned space perpendicular to the mounting surface. These diffusers are typically used for applications needing high air change rates, and/or low local velocities. Some outlet models are flush to the mounting surface; others protrude into the space below the ceiling. Most function similarly with or without an adjacent ceiling surface.

Laminar Diffuser. Sometimes called **nonaspirating**, this diffuser provides a unidirectional discharge perpendicular to the mounting surface. The free area of the perforated face is typically less than 35%. Most outlets are designed to develop a uniform velocity profile over the full face of the diffuser. This minimizes mixing with surrounding ambient air and reduces entrainment of any surrounding contaminants. These diffusers are typically used in hospital operating rooms, cleanrooms, or laboratories.

Linear Slot Diffuser. Linear slot diffusers may be installed in multiple sections to achieve long, continuous lengths, or installed as a discrete length. They can consist of a single slot or multiple slots and are available in configurations that provide vertical to horizontal airflow. Typically, a supply air plenum is provided separately and attached between the diffuser and the duct during installation. Other applications include field mounting the linear slot diffuser directly into a supply duct.

T-Bar Slot Diffuser. This diffuser is manufactured with an integral plenum and normally is installed in modular suspended (T-bar) ceilings. Available with fixed-deflection or adjustable-pattern controllers, these devices can discharge air from vertical to horizontal.

Light Troffer Diffuser. A light troffer diffuser serves as the combined plenum, inlet, and attachment device to an air-handling light fixture, which has a slot to receive the diffuser at or near the face of the lighting device, to discharge supply air into the space. Only the air-handling slot is visible from the occupied space.

Swirl Diffuser. This diffuser features a series of openings arranged in a radial pattern around the center of the diffuser face. This promotes a high degree of entrainment of room air, resulting in very high induction ratios, which maximize mixing in the area adjacent to the diffuser face. Swirl diffusers may be mounted in ceiling, sidewall, or floor locations. They are commonly used for UFAD applications where it is necessary to locate the supply outlets close to the space occupants. When mounted in floor locations, care should be taken to ensure that the diffuser can meet the floor loading requirements.

Displacement Diffuser. Typically located in floor or low-sidewall locations, this diffuser is designed to limit discharge velocities to 0.2 to 0.36 m/s to minimize mixing between supply and room air. These outlets tend be large to generate the low velocities required for thermal displacement ventilation: low-velocity discharge allows the cooler supply air to fall to the floor and remain there because its buoyancy is lower than that of the ambient room air above it. These outlets are available in various shapes and configurations that facilitate flush or adjacent mounting to the sidewalls or floor of the space.

Textile Air Dispersion System. This outlet system is designed to both convey and disperse air within the space being conditioned. Diffusion options include outlets selected for a full range of entrainment. The supply air is delivered through (1) the weave of the fabric, (2) microperforations, (3) a long and narrow pattern of small jets, (4) orifices, and/or (5) nozzles. Typically, these systems are made of fabric, sheet metal, or plastic film.

Variable-Air-Volume (VAV) Diffuser. A VAV diffuser is an air outlet that self-modulates its primary air flow rate with an integral air damper. Select outlets based on the total range of airflow for the space served. Outlet performance characteristics should be evaluated at both minimum and maximum flow. More information regarding selection of outlets can be found in Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Variable Geometry Diffuser. One type of VAV outlet is a variable geometry diffuser. These diffuser assemblies vary their dis-

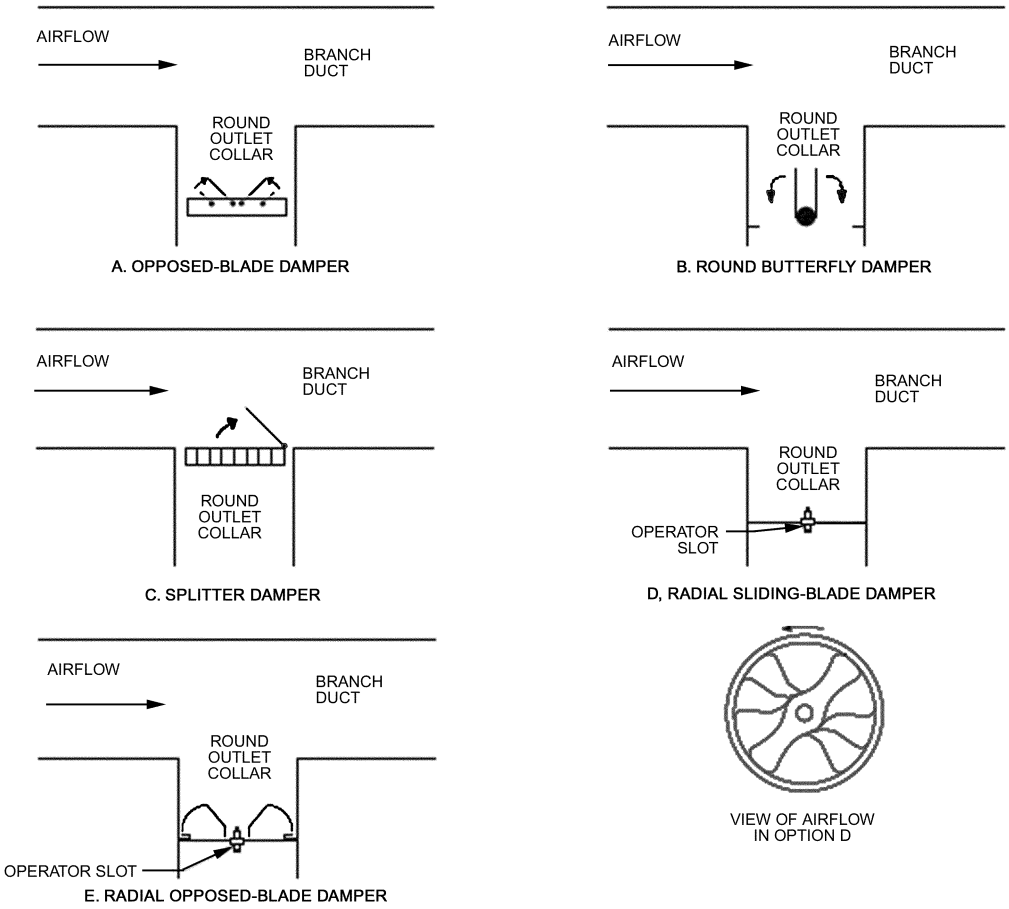

Fig. 4 Accessory Controls for Ceiling Diffusers

charge area or air pattern in response to changes in space or supply air temperature.

Supply Air Diffuser Accessories

Dampers can be attached to grilles (the combination of a grille and a damper is called a **register**), diffusers, or installed as separate units in the duct, to regulate the device's airflow rate:

- **Opposed-blade** damper vanes rotate in opposite directions (Figure 3A and 4A) and are available for round, square, or rectangular necks.
- **Parallel-blade** dampers rotate in the same direction (Figure 3B).
- **Adjustable-vane** dampers have individually adjustable vanes.
- **Butterfly** dampers are constructed with opposing damper plates that move in opposite directions and are adjusted from a center point (Figure 4B).
- A **splitter** damper is a single-blade device, hinged at one edge and usually located at the branch connection of a duct or outlet (Figure 4C). The device is designed to allow adjustment at the branch connection of a duct or outlet to adjust flow.
- **Radial** sliding dampers consist of multiple overlapping flat blades that rotate in the horizontal plane to restrict the airstream (Figure 4D).
- **Radial opposed blade dampers** consist of a series of radial blades that pivot to restrict the airstream (Figure 4E).

Other miscellaneous accessories, such as **remote control devices** to operate the dampers, and **travel limit stops**, are also available.

When these dampers are located on or near the air outlet, they may cause nonuniform airflow discharge and increased pressure drop and sound. In the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, Chapter 49 describes the effects of damper location on sound level and Chapter 58 addresses the effects of damper location on sound, throw performance, and pressure drop.

Extractors are installed in duct-collar connections to the outlet and are used to improve the flow distribution into a supply outlet. The device shown in Figure 3C has vanes that pivot such that the supply airflow to the grille or register remains perpendicular to the face of the outlet. The device shown in Figure 3D has fixed vanes. Both devices restrict the area of the duct in which they are installed and should be used only when the duct is large enough to allow the device to open to its maximum position without unduly restricting airflow to the downstream duct. These devices may increase the system pressure requirement, thereby limiting downstream airflow and increasing the sound level. An extractor mounted directly to the grille, as shown in Figure 3F, is sometimes called a **scoop**.

Adjustable vanes, as shown in Figure 3E, are individually adjustable. Typically, two sets of vanes are used. One set equalizes flow across the collar, and the other set turns the air. The vanes should not be adjusted to act as a damper because balancing requires removing the grille to gain access and then reinstalling it to measure airflow.

Equalizing or **flow-straightening devices** or **grids** allow adjustment of the airstream to obtain more uniform flow to the diffuser.

Quadrant blank-off flat plates restrict airflow in one or more quadrant(s) of the diffuser inlet.

Other balancing devices are available. Consult manufacturers' literature as a source of information for other air-balancing devices.

3.6 TERMINAL UNITS

In air distribution systems, special control and acoustical equipment is frequently required to introduce conditioned air into a space properly. Airflow controls for these systems consist principally of terminal units, the most common of which historically were called **VAV boxes**, with which the airflow can be varied by modulating valves, fan controls, or both. Terminal units such as those listed here are supplied with or without cooling coils, fans, heat or reheat coils, and having either constant or variable primary airflow rate. Terminal units typically control the flow of conditioned air supplied through a duct from an air handler and deliver it to the occupied space, but sometimes, such as in the case of underfloor units located in a cooled supply air plenum, may take the air directly from the plenum with no primary duct. They may use a ducted or nonducted return plenum or room air induction to affect space temperature control while maintaining a constant or variable discharge airflow rate and/or temperature. Terminal units may also include, usually as accessories, sound reduction devices, diffusers, filters, or other air treatment devices.

This section discusses control equipment for forced air-conditioning systems. Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* includes information on sound control in air-conditioning systems and sound ratings for air outlets.

Terminal units are factory-made assemblies for affecting air distribution. A terminal unit manually or automatically performs one or more of the following functions: (1) controls air velocity, airflow rate, pressure, or temperature; (2) mixes primary air from the duct system with air from the treated space or from a secondary duct system; and (3) heats or cools the air. To achieve these functions, terminal unit assemblies are made from an appropriate selection of the following components: casing, mixing section, manual or automatic air control device, heat exchanger, induction section (with or without fan), sound reduction devices, and flow controller.

Terminal units are typically classified as constant or variable air flow rate devices. They are further categorized as either pressure-dependent, where airflow through the assembly varies in response to changes in system pressure, or pressure-independent or -compensating, where airflow through the device does not vary in response to changes in air pressure.

Variable-air-volume (VAV) reset controllers regulate airflow to a constant, fixed amount or to a variable, modulating amount calculated by room demand. These controllers can be electric (typically yielding pressure-dependent performance), analog, or digital electronic (giving pressure independence), or pneumatic with pressure-dependent or -independent flow. Pressure-independent controllers require an indication of actual airflow to reset the VAV airflow control device. Temperature inputs are also required for calculating room demand for comfort conditioning.

Terminal unit controls are categorized as (1) system-powered, in which the airflow control device derives the energy necessary for operation from supply air within the distribution system; or (2) externally powered, in which the airflow control device derives its energy from a pneumatic or electric outside source. Terminal units may be furnished with all necessary controls for their operation, including actuators, regulators, motors, and thermostats or space temperature sensors, or the controls may be furnished by someone other than the terminal unit manufacturer.

The unit's flow control device can be adjusted manually or automatically. If the unit is adjusted automatically, it is actuated by a control signal from a controller, thermostat, flow regulator, or building management system (BMS), depending on the desired function of the terminal unit.

Single-Duct Terminal Units

Single-duct terminal units can be cooling only, heating only, or cooling and heating. Terminal units for cooling modes often have reheat coils that add sensible heat to the supply air as part of the overall humidity control. Hot-water or steam coils, or electric resistance heaters, are placed in or attached directly to the air discharge of the terminal unit. This type of equipment can provide varying reheat, customized to the thermal zone being served.

The basic single-duct unit consists of an insulated casing, airflow regulator, and possibly also an actuator, airflow-measuring device, and selected controls. Accessory discharge attenuators, silencers, and multiple outlet attenuators are also common. In the lower and middle latitudes, typical applications include those with

- The supply air system is not tasked with the space heating requirements
- Variable airflow rate and temperature (VVT) or other auto-changeover controls
- Constant air volume
- Constant pressure control

A **single-duct unit with a reheat** can also be used in zones where heating-mode needs are low so that the reheat coil can serve dual purposes. The terminal unit usually reheats at the minimum airflow setting. An auxiliary higher heating setting may be available as an option with additional controls.

Interior zones, where ventilation requirements may be larger than the desired heating airflow, may require additional reheat capacity.

A **single-duct exhaust valve** is a type of single-duct ATU (air terminal unit) designed for exhaust air and consists of an insulated casing, airflow regulator, and possibly also an actuator, airflow-measuring device, and selected controls. Accessory inlet attenuators or silencers are sometimes used. Specialty materials may be needed for corrosion resistance. The designer should consider pressure drop and system effects.

A **venturi valve** is a type of single-duct ATU and can be used for either supply or exhaust. Traditionally, the device consisted of a round venturi valve body and an internal shaft that supports a cone assembly. Newer technologies remove the internal cone assembly and use damper blade assemblies to control airflow.

Cone Assembly Type. The cone assembly is spring-loaded on the shaft. As pressure in the primary duct increases, the cone compresses the internal spring and moves closer to the venturi throat, increasing resistance to the airstream. As pressure in the primary duct decreases, the spring retracts and the cone assembly moves farther from the venturi throat, decreasing resistance to the airstream. This is called **mechanical pressure independence**. If the venturi valve is provided with an actuator to allow for variable airflow, the actuator and positioning arm reposition the shaft, which in turn moves the cone assembly relative to the throat, changing the airflow.

Damper Assembly Type. The damper assembly is controlled by an actuator that responds to differential pressure between two different points along the venturi valve body or by other means. The damper modulates to control airflow as pressure fluctuates, yielding a **pressure-independent** system that directly measures airflow through the valve body. A controller is used to modulate the valve damper actuator and control the overall system sequence of operation, whether constant volume or variable volume.

Dual-Duct Terminal Units

Dual-duct terminal units are typically controlled by a room thermostat or sensor. They are each connected to two supply air ducts

that deliver two of warm, cold, recirculated, mixed, or outside air to provide desired room control. Volume-regulated units have individual airflow control devices to regulate the amount of air from the two supply ducts. Dual-duct units can have reheat coils too if mixing of the hot and cold ducts' air is insufficient for humidity control or space heating. When a single temperature control device regulates the relative amounts of both warm and cold air to control temperature, a separate airflow control device may function to control and limit total airflow from the unit. Specially designed baffles may be required inside the unit or at its discharge to mix varying amounts of warm and cold air and/or to provide uniform temperature distribution downstream. Dual-duct units can be equipped with constant- or variable-flow control. These are typically pressure independent, to provide consistent flow rate and temperature control. Dual-duct terminals may also be used with outdoor air conditioned and supplied by a primary air-handling unit and ducted to the terminal units; such systems' AHUs maintain the required volumetric flow of ventilation air into the spaces served. Dual-duct units with cooling and outdoor air may need a local heating device; these **primary-secondary** air distribution systems thus need careful analysis and design.

A **nonmixing dual-duct unit** is effectively two single-duct terminal units side by side. The basic unit incorporates separate cold and hot air inlets that are to be attached to the two primary-air ducts, with sometimes neutral-temperature air in one of the ducts (e.g., during mild weather). The units are usually applied in exterior zones in buildings where overhead heating and cooling are desired but not auxiliary heating, and when zero minimum airflow is acceptable during changeover between heating and cooling. Proper discharge configurations are required to reduce the likelihood of improper mixing.

A **mixing dual-duct unit** is the same, with an integral mixing/attenuator section on the downstream end of the terminal unit to minimize temperature stratification in the discharge airstream. They are often used in interior and exterior zones in buildings (e.g., hospitals) where overhead heating and cooling are desired, but an auxiliary heating coil is not, and zero minimum airflow is unacceptable during changeover between heating and cooling. Evaluate mixing performance to fit the application, and consider the additional pressure drop of mixing/attenuators sections.

Air-to-Air Induction Terminal Units

Induction terminals supply primary air or a mixture of primary and recirculated air to the conditioned space. They achieve this function with a primary air jet that induces recirculated air, known as secondary air in this application, via grilles to the ceiling plenum or from individual rooms via a return duct. Typically, the primary air is of higher design velocity than that delivered to other types of terminal units, and the extra momentum is used as the inducing energy source. The induction unit contains devices that are actuated in response to a thermostat to modulate the mixture of primary air and induced secondary air. Reheat coils may be required to meet interior load requirements. Historically, induction units were used with high-velocity ducts, and often produced much noise. Modern versions often work well with much lower-velocity air but require careful selection. Generally, induction units are considered where there is a desire for zone-level air distribution equipment, installed in or over occupied spaces, that have no fans or other components that may require frequent access for maintenance. Any terminal unit that uses recirculated air must have an air filter, and that filter should be readily accessible for inspection and periodic replacement.

Fan-Powered Terminal Units

Fan-powered terminal units are used as secondary-level air handlers in primary-secondary air distribution systems and are typically installed in return air plenums. They can be specified with either heating, reheating, or cooling coils, or a combination. They differ from air-to-air induction units in that they each include a blower, driven by a small motor, which moves air from the conditioned space, ceiling plenum, or floor plenum, that may be mixed with the primary air from the main air handler. The characteristics of fan-powered units are

- In heating mode, the primary air is mixed with usually warmer or cooler secondary air that then passes through the unit's heating coil.
- The unit's fan increases supply air pressure to deliver air to areas that otherwise would be short of airflow.
- With heating or cooling coils in the units, perimeter zones can be heated or cooled without operating the main air handler when ventilation with outdoor air is not required.
- In-room air velocities can be kept consistently high to improve mixing.
- Air velocities may be reduced in low-load conditions to decrease noise levels.
- The main air handler operating pressure can be reduced with series fan-powered units compared to other terminal units because the secondary-level fans provide some of the total needed supply air pressure differential and may yield some fan-energy savings.
- In thermal storage and other systems with relatively low supply air temperatures, series fan-powered terminal units may be used to mix the cold supply air with much warmer induced return or plenum air, to moderate the discharge air temperature.

Some units are equipped with special insulation and a vapor retarder to reduce condensation with below-dewpoint supply temperatures.

Fan-powered terminal units can be divided into two categories: (1) series, with all primary and induced air passing through a blower in the unit that operates continuously during the occupied mode; and (2) parallel, in which the blower operates only on demand when induced air or heat is required.

Fan-powered terminal units typically use fractional horsepower alternating current (ac) electric motors for their included blowers. Increasingly, high-efficiency electrically commutated motors (ECMs) are used instead of older, less efficient motor designs. The efficiency of the motor becomes more important as the units operate for more hours of each year.

A **series** unit typically has two inlets, one for primary air from the central air handler and one for secondary air recirculated from the spaces served, often via a ceiling or floor plenum. All air delivered to the zone passes through the blower. The blower operates continuously whenever the primary air fan is on and can be cycled as required when the primary fan is off. As the zone's load decreases, an airflow control device throttles the amount of primary air delivered to the blower. The blower makes up for this reduced amount of primary air by acquiring more air from the conditioned space or ceiling plenum through its secondary air inlet. Sometimes a series unit has two ducted inlets, like a dual-duct terminal unit, in addition to the induction air inlet, which may or may not have ducting to it. The second primary air duct is typically used for dedicated outdoor air systems. Fan airflow and primary air can be varied when the units are in part-load condition, but fan airflow should never be less than the total amount of air supplied to the unit by the ducted inlets.

Fan-Powered Series Flow. The basic unit consists of a single-duct unit, blower/motor, and selected controls where the motor and primary damper are arranged such that mixing occurs upstream of the blower; this unit is depicted in Figure 5. They also have been called **constant-volume** or **constant-fan** units. Supplemental heating coils, such as steam, hot water, or electric, are generally required. Electric-resistance heating coils are typically located on

the discharge of the unit; water coils may be on the discharge or the induction port. Heating coils on the induction port, and thus upstream of the unit's blower, increase ambient temperature at its motor and decrease motor life. Supplemental cooling coils are sometimes located on the induction port for some applications like when utilized in conjunction with dedicated outdoor air systems. A **low-profile** version of the fan-powered series flow unit is typically less than 300 mm tall and is commonly used where zoning requirements limit building height and the architect wishes to maximize the number of floors, because these units fit in a shallow ceiling plenum. Unlike standard fan-powered terminals, the fan/motor assembly is installed flat on its side with the wheel rotating in a horizontal plane.

Fan-powered series-flow units are generally used for

- Exterior zones where heating and cooling loads may vary considerably
- Buildings where heating is desired when the central system is shut down during unoccupied hours
- Allowing lower central system supply duct static pressure
- Where occupant comfort can be optimized, because the high-, sometimes constant-, volume variable-temperature air delivery produces consistent air distribution, acoustics, and ventilation air delivery

Dual Air Inlet Fan-Powered Series Flow. These units are similar in construction to the standard series-flow terminals but have an additional air inlet that provides a direct connection to the terminal unit for ventilation air. They are commonly used in buildings where ventilation air is supplied via a dedicated ventilation duct system to each terminal unit; this is generally done where it is desirable to monitor ventilation air quantities to each zone.

Low-Temperature Fan-Powered Series Flow. These units are the same as fan-powered series flow but have special construction to minimize the potential for condensation. They can be used with cold-water/ice storage systems that provide below-dewpoint temperature primary air to the zone terminals, or where standard terminals may be exposed to high humidity.

Underfloor Fan-Powered Series Flow. This type is a fan-powered series flow terminal unit designed to fit between the pedestal supports of raised- or access-floor systems. They are available in several unit sizes, but with limited height and width.

Primary and induction ports, if any, to such units may or may not be ducted. Typically, in cooling mode, cool primary air is supplied to the well-sealed floor plenum, and heated air may be ducted to the terminal unit that is then mixed with the cool air in varying amounts. In these cases, the control system must perform the proper damper sequence to control room air conditions.

Parallel fan-powered terminal units, in cooling mode, supply the primary air directly to the space, bypassing its fan. In heating mode, the blower section induces plenum air and is mounted in parallel with the primary airflow control device, this unit is depicted in Figure 6. A backdraft damper is included to limit the amount of primary air flowing through the blower section when the blower is not energized. The blower in these units is generally energized after the primary airflow has reached the minimum flow rate. Typically, the parallel unit provides constant-air flow rate heating and variable air flow rate cooling. Although it is not recommended due to control instability, these units are sometimes applied in CAV mode with electronically commutated motors programmed to maintain constant airflow rate discharge. The motor control algorithm gradually increases the unit's fan speed as the primary airflow is reduced. Parallel units are typically limited to one ducted supply inlet.

One weakness in parallel fan-powered terminals is leakage of primary air through the fan's backdraft damper and the mixing chamber housing. ASHRAE research project (RP-1292 (David 2007) demonstrated that much of the energy saving associated with

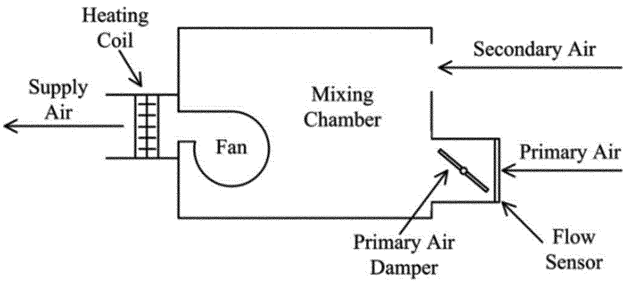

Fig. 5 Series Fan-Powered Terminal Unit

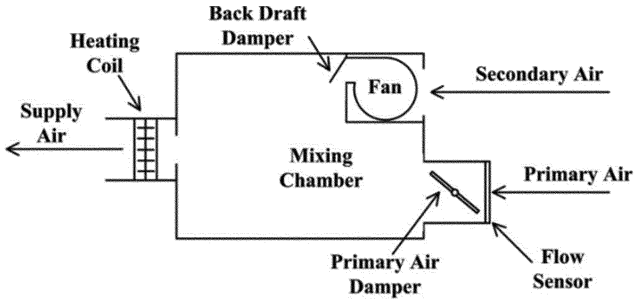

Fig. 6 Parallel Fan-Powered Terminal Unit

intermittent fan cycling is offset, and in fact may be significantly less than the energy loss caused by this leakage.

Fan-Powered Chilled Water Series Flow. This unit type takes all the features of a basic fan-powered series flow unit and incorporates a supplemental cooling coil on the induction port. Typically, this cooling coil is designed for sensible cooling only, to avoid condensation issues and in many cases, is used in conjunction with dedicated outdoor air systems.

Fan-Powered Parallel Flow. Sometimes called **variable-volume** or **intermittent-fan units**, these consist of a single-duct unit, blower/ motor, backdraft damper, and selected controls; the motor and primary damper are arranged such that mixing occurs downstream of the blower. Supplemental heating coils, either steam, hot water, or electric, are generally required. Electric-resistance heating coils are typically located on the discharge of the unit. Water coils may be on the discharge or the induction port, although the discharge location adds to the supply air system's static pressure requirements and increases leakage through the backdraft damper, as shown in ASHRAE RP-1292 (Davis 2007). Heating coils on the induction port increase the air temperature at the unit's fan motor and decrease its life.

Fan-powered parallel-flow units are used in exterior zones where heating and cooling loads may vary considerably, and in buildings where heating is needed when the central air handler is shut down during unoccupied hours.

Bypass Terminal Units. A bypass terminal unit handles primary air through its inlet. The unit bypasses primary air to the ceiling plenum or to ducts leading to the air handler's return to meet the needs of the conditioned space. Primary air, diverted into the ceiling plenum, returns to the central air handler as return air or building exhaust. This method provides a low first cost with minimum controls, but it is energy inefficient compared to other systems.

The basic bypass terminal consists of a diverter-type damper, actuator, bypass port, and selected pressure-dependent controls. A balancing damper is recommended ahead of the inlet.

Bypass terminals are used primarily with packaged rooftop air conditioning equipment with a direct-expansion (DX) coil where zoning is desired, but relatively constant airflows across the system

components (e.g., coils, fans) are required to minimize the potential for freeze-up. The system offers a lower initial cost design. It does not provide the energy-saving advantages of a VAV system with fan-speed control; almost all the energy savings are from the reduced motor speeds that occur except at full design-load conditions.

3.7 FAN-COIL UNITS

This section discusses the use of hydronic and direct-expansion (DX) fan-coil units to control the flow rate and temperature of air delivered to the space as required to maintain occupant thermal comfort and/or ventilation rate. Chapter 5 discusses how fan-coil units are integrated into the design of the building. Fan-coils operate independently of any central air distribution system or are used similarly to some fan-powered terminal units.

There are various fan-coil systems to choose from when designing a building. Choosing which one to use depends on the building owner's considering installation, application, operational cost, sustainability, thermal and acoustic performance, capacity, reliability, spatial requirements, code restrictions, water or refrigerant piping distribution, maintenance, and unit accessibility.

Fan-coil units are factory-made assemblies, and are typically much smaller than traditional, centrally installed air-handling units. The fan-coil performs some combination of the following functions: (1) temperature and humidity control, (2) ventilation of the conditioned space, (3) filtration, and (4) room air distribution, including providing air motion for comfort. Their blowers, when in operation, may provide beneficial acoustical masking in the spaces served. Fan-coil units are available in various configurations, including vertical or horizontal airflow paths and mounts for exposed or concealed locations in spaces. A zone temperature control device regulates the fan-coil airflow rate or discharge air temperature, or possibly both.

As shown in Figure 7, the basic components of fan-coil units are an integral or external filter frame, a heating or cooling coil, and fan. Both heating and cooling coils may be included, depending on the needs of the thermal zone. The zone temperature control device may be part of the fan-coil unit or supplied separately. Air entering the unit may be 100% recirculated air or a mixture of recirculated and outside air. The fan moves air from the conditioned space through the coil or coils, which then transfers heat to or from the air. Fans are usually placed after the coils (draw-through arrangements), but some fans are installed before the coils (blow-through). The coils use steam, chilled or hot water, or refrigerant (DX), or are electric resistance-heating elements. A filter is required at or upstream of the unit's inlet to minimize airborne particulates to keep downstream components cleaner. The fan and motor assembly are generally arranged for quick removal for servicing. The fan may be directly or indirectly driven by its electric motor. If the unit includes a dehumidifying cooling coil, it must be equipped with a drain pan and drain for the condensate; an insulated pan may be desirable. Fan-coil casings are typically galvanized or painted steel and may be prepped and painted after installation, but care is needed not to cover permanent informational labels. The casing may be internally insulated for both thermal and acoustic considerations.

Additional components are offered for many fan-coil units for specific applications, including fan controls (e.g., modulating fan controls), thyristor control, or electronically commutated motors (ECMs). A hydronic coil's water valve piping package can include such components as manual or automatic flow controls, pressure-independent water control valves, strainers, unions, pressure-temperature ports, air vents, hose connections, drains, and balancing valves. The coil in a DX system includes a fixed refrigerant expansion orifice device such as a capillary tube or a thermal expansion valve. Electric heating controls include magnetic contact closure or solid-state relays.

Fan-coil units are generally available in nominal sizes from95 to 1135 L/s or 2 to 21 kW, with direct drive permanent split capacitor (PSC) fan motors or ECMs for a wide range of applications. These units can be used in ducted or nonducted single or multiroom applications. They typically have multiple-row cooling coils and may have single- or multiple-row heating coils. If a two-pipe hydronic system for seasonal heating or cooling is used, only one coil may be included; however, four-pipe systems with separate heating and cooling coils are generally recommended for improved comfort and overall efficiency. If steam is used instead of hot water, it requires a separate coil. In a DX system, its coil is most often cooling-only, but heat pump applications are increasingly of interest. For heat pump applications, specifying an electric resistance heating coil is often also recommended. Fan-coil unit systems can

- Require less building interstitial space, because the water/refrigerant piping system has a higher energy density per unit fluid flow than an all-air system
- Provide individual-zone temperature and humidity control
- Enable retrofits to expand capacity beyond that of the existing air system.
- Allow individual dwellings in multifamily buildings to have individual electrical meters and separate air flows versus a central AHU
- Provide occupants with independent temperature controls

DX fan-coil systems also eliminate the need for a central chiller plant. However, for DX fan-coil units in high-rise buildings, the space required for mounting condensing units and the lift required for oil in refrigerant lines must be considered. Minisplit and VRF systems that use a ducted indoor fan-coil unit are available for high-rise and other applications, too.

Two- and Four-Pipe Hydronic Distribution Systems. When the heating and cooling heat transfer fluids, typically treated water, are supplied to a common coil in each terminal unit, it is called a two-pipe system, with one pipe for supply and one for return. These are also called a heating/cooling changeover system. A four-pipe distribution system has dedicated supply and return piping for the separate heating and cooling coils, or each circuit within a common coil. The four-pipe system generally has a higher initial cost; however, it provides (1) all-season availability of heating and cooling at each unit, (2) no summer/winter changeover requirement at the terminal units, (3) controllability to maintain an energy-saving dead band between heating and cooling, and (4) heating coil arrangements for either preheat or reheat.

A two-pipe system can only heat or cool, depending on the supply water temperature. During intermediate seasons or when the building requires simultaneous heating and cooling, supplemental electric heat is usually provided. The coil is typically sized larger for cooling, so careful consideration of the heating water temperature is required; often it is lower than for a dedicated hydronic heating coil.

Motors and Controls. When selecting a motor type, consider features such as control type, control scheme, and sequence of operation. The differences between a permanent split capacitor (PSC) versus an electronically commutated motor (ECM) affect the

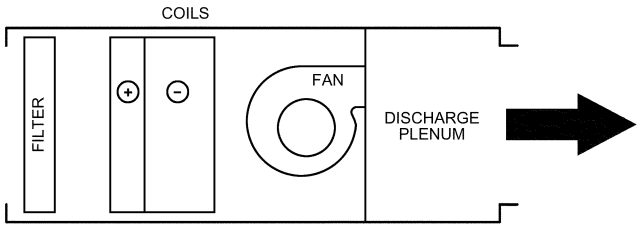

Fig. 7 Basic Fan-Coil Unit

sequence of operation, which in turn dictates type of room thermostats, controls, and water valves. When an ECM is used in a fan-coil, both the fan motor and water control valve are typically modulated by a controller based on room demand.

The most common control for fan-coils is a room thermostat. These thermostats come in both line voltage (i.e., same voltage as motor) and 24 VAC; generally, a lower control loop voltage is preferred due to safety expectations. Both thermostats offer simple on/off or multispeed control of fan motors and open/close control of water control valves, although programmable versions are readily available that adjust the temperature set point for expected occupancy variations (i.e., setback thermostats).

Analog controllers can provide high level of control for modulating components such as ECMs, water valves, and silicon-controlled rectifiers (SCRs). The most advanced level of building control is provided by direct digital control (DDC), which adds communication ability through a building automation system (BAS).

Additional information on fan-coil unit motors and controls can be found in Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications.*

Unit Types and Configurations. Fan-coil units are available in many different configurations; however, not all configurations discussed here are available for all types of units. Orientation of airflow from return to supply, unit features, and dimensional characteristics constitute the major differences between configurations. Outdoor air can be mixed with recirculated air in the plenum or at the fan-coil unit or be delivered directly to the space separately from the fan-coil's supply air. Changes in industry standards have increased the use of coupling ventilation air to fan-coil units. The outdoor air can be pretreated or unconditioned and ducted or nonducted. Fan-coil units are available with a variety of options to handle outdoor air, such as mixing boxes, outdoor air duct collars, air measuring devices, or air control devices.

Vertical Units. Low-profile vertical fan-coil units (called sill units or cabinet heaters) are typically used beneath or adjacent to windows or exterior walls in concealed or exposed cabinets. The low silhouette sometimes limits filter area, serviceability, capacity, and cabinet geometry. Air is discharged vertically through grilles mounted on the top face of the enclosure. Controls and water valves are typically located in the enclosure, with access from the room for maintenance.

Vertical, high-output fan-coil units are designed for larger spaces or multiple rooms. The units are typically located in a closet, where a door allows easy access. Ducted discharge air supplies multiple outlets located throughout the space. The return is typically located near the floor of the closet and may or may not be ducted. Typically, one thermostat controls the air temperature supplied to all the spaces served.

Vertical stack fan-coil units, as depicted in Figure 8, are typically mounted in walls of or vertical chases in the conditioned space, such as near the window of a hotel or dorm room. Air is discharged into the space from high sidewall grilles or ducted to outlets throughout the zone. Multiple stack units may be connected to a common set of risers to serve adjacent spaces. The pipes can be in a cavity protected by fire-rated partitions separating multiple adjacent zones.

Floor-to-floor, vertical stack fan-coil units are typically supplied with chilled- and/or hot-water risers and return downcomers, and a condensate downcomer. VRF versions are available too, as are water-cooled heat pumps units. Vertical stack fan-coils with integral prefabricated risers located directly above one another can reduce installation labor and time. Evaluation of floor-to-floor centerlines is critical for riser and unit heights.

Horizontal Units. Horizontal overhead units may be concealed or exposed, and some have discharge or return ducts. Discharge ducts may supply several outlets in one or more rooms. Ducted units must be designed to handle higher external static pressure. Horizontal models conserve floor space, but when located in furred ceilings, consideration should be given to access and condensate removal. This type of fan-coil is oft-used, for example, in plenums over hallways in hotels, apartments, and condominiums. The cooling is most often a DX split-system, and heating is heat pump or electric resistance. Minisplit and VRF versions are available too.

Figure 9 shows a typical low-profile horizontal fur-down fan-coil unit. Horizontal fur-down units are generally less than 280 mm in height and mounted in a fur-down below the ceiling level or in a soffit area. The return is nonducted, typically through filter-return grilles; the interstitial area of the soffit is the return plenum, which otherwise must be very well sealed. Supply air is typically ducted to one or more two-way high-sidewall supply grilles. Horizontal fan-coil types are generally used in space-constrained applications. A variation of the horizontal furdown unit includes a larger return plenum, which has filter-frame accommodations and may be ducted to a return grille. The addition of a return plenum with an externally finished cabinet allows the fan-coil unit to be installed below the ceiling.

High-capacity, horizontal fan-coil units are generally up to 460 mm in height and mounted above the ceiling in a return air plenum. These models have a higher capacity than fur-down low-profile units, and generally serve multiple rooms with a ducted supply. The unit may have multiple plenum arrangements, like fur-down models do, but the interstitial area is typically the return plenum.

Underfloor Fan Coils. This fan-coil is like an underfloor fan-powered terminal, but it includes a cooling coil to boost the cooling load at the perimeter of zones or, for example, in conference rooms with raised floors. Another use may be in staircases or podiums. If the cooling coil is designed to condense water vapor when operating, care must be taken to provide for adequate drainage. Condensate pumps may be required. These fan-coils are available in several unit sizes, but with limited height and width to fit under the raised floor.

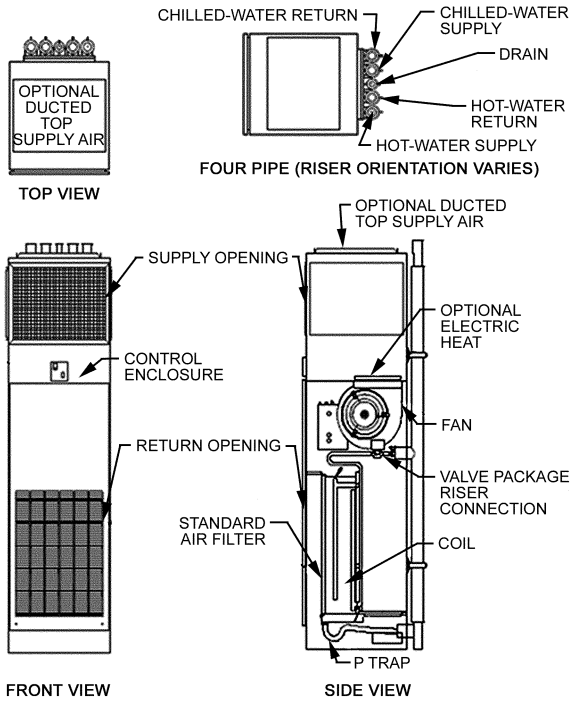

Fig. 8 Typical Vertical Fan-Coil Unit

For fan-coil applications in raised floors, typically either the supply or return air is ducted, and thus the plenum is used for unducted flow of the other. The plenum must, therefore, be very well sealed so that air does not leak in or out of unintended places; alternatively, both the supply and return can be ducted and well sealed. In all cases, the control system must have the proper damper sequence to control room air distribution to maintain the proper conditions in the occupied space.

Maintenance. Fan-coil systems require maintenance, which is generally done via the occupied areas. Unit accessibility is important for inspections and when performing routine maintenance such as filter replacement, coil and drain cleaning, and motor servicing. Large fire-rated hatches may be required when units are placed in small plenums, for example. When above suspended ceilings, the movable ceiling tiles may provide adequate access and fire rating.

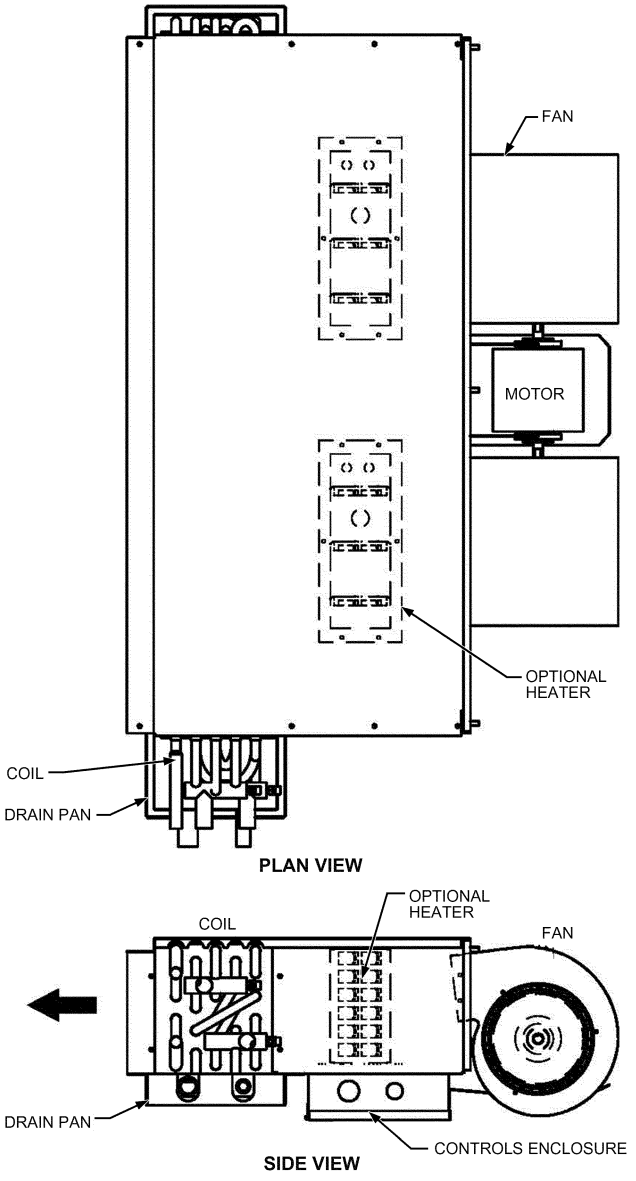

Fig. 9 Typical Horizontal Fan-Coil Unit

3.8 CHILLED BEAMS

Chilled-beam systems are designed to address most or all the zone's sensible heat gains or losses locally using water, allowing the flow rate of preconditioned air from the air-handling unit to be reduced to maintain only the required latent cooling and ventilation of the space. This often results in ducted design airflow rate reductions of 60 to 80%, and thus similar reductions in air distribution equipment capacity requirements. Chilled-water supply temperatures are maintained at or above the room air dew point to prevent condensation on the beam heat transfer coil(s). The zone must be very well sealed and air pressure differential optimized continuously to effectively eliminate infiltration of uncontrolled humid air. Chilled-beam systems perform the following functions:

- Temperature control (sensible cooling and heating)
- Latent cooling (when using drain pans or inductions units)
- Room air distribution
- Ventilation (active chilled beams)
- Humidity control (active chilled beams)

Beam Types and Configurations

Active beams, as shown in Figure 10A are induction terminals that consist of a primary air duct connection, a series of induction nozzles, hydronic heat transfer coil(s), supply outlet(s), and induced air inlet section(s). Primary air, discharged through the induction nozzles, creates a lower-pressure region that induces room air through the chilled- and/or hot-water coil(s). The room air is conditioned before being mixed with primary air, and then the mixture of primary and conditioned induced air is then discharged to the space. This mixture's temperature and/or flow rate is modulated in accordance with the space demand and control strategy. Active chilled beams are available in the following configurations:

- Linear (one-way or two-way discharge)
- Modular (four-way discharge)
- Recessed
- Floor mounted or cabinet style
- Induction units (with integral drain pans)

Active beams, when properly applied, generally produce fully mixed room air distribution, although displacement ventilation versions (cabinet style) are available as well. Their air distribution characteristics depend on the beam's supply outlet configuration, like those described in Table 1. Most active beams use linear slots on their discharge, and room air distribution is therefore characteristic of that outlet type because the induced air produces significant supply air velocity. The following piping configurations are generally used:

- Two-pipe
- Four-pipe
- Two-pipe changeover (six-way valve)

Cooling-only active beams use two pipes (supply and return) to their coils. Active beams can also be used for overhead heating; when applied as such, the beams are typically provided with four-pipe combined coils. These beams' coils have a common fin stack, but the tubing that passes through the stack is dedicated to either cooling or heating. In most cases, 75% of the tube passes are dedicated to cooling, and 25% are supplied hot water. The water flow rate through either circuit is varied by zone chilled- and/or hot-water control valves that are modulated the zone temperature sensor.

Where both heating and cooling are needed but two-pipe beams are used, six-port control valves can be effective. These valves incorporate four supply and return ports for both chilled and hot water. They then determine the water source that is required and modulate the flow to and from one or more two-pipe beams through a shared local two-pipe system. This can considerably reduce zone piping costs and allow the use of more efficient two-pipe circuitry in

the beam heat transfer coils; however, it loses the ability to heat or cool each beam individually, if jointly connected on a local two-pipe system.

Overhead beams, if so designed, may be used in suspended or finished ceilings, or independently mounted below. Although active beams are usually installed in the upper part of the space, they can also be located in sidewalls or at floor level, with their supply air delivered at high or low velocity, depending on the air distribution strategy (mixing or displacement) that is desired. Both active and passive chilled beams can be integrated with additional services (e.g., lighting or fire protection) as required.

Passive beams, as shown in Figure 10B, consist of a sensible cooling coil and a casing, and can be fitted into an architectural enclosure when exposed. They provide space sensible cooling mainly by negative-buoyancy-driven natural convection: the coil provides heat exchange between the chilled water and the induced room air. When cool water is circulated through the coil, room air between the fins is cooled and falls naturally into the room. Displaced room air then pushes air through the beam's coil.

There are two basic types of passive beams: exposed and recessed. Exposed passive beams are commonly used in spaces without suspended ceilings (i.e., in rooms with either finished or no ceilings).

Recessed passive beams are generally integrated into a suspended ceiling. When passive beams are installed in such a ceiling, a minimum clearance between the top of the beam and any surface above it should be provided to ensure a sufficient return air path. Generous shadow gaps, dummy beam sections, and/or return or transfer grilles are recommended for creating the near-zero pressure loss return air path from the room to the plenum.

Passive beams cannot be used effectively for heating spaces below them due to positive air buoyancy. Instead, a decoupled heating system (e.g., low-level finned tube or radiant panels or floors) is commonly used. However, the passive beams may be used at times to intentionally warm the plenum or floor above them somewhat, for comfort or freeze protection.

Space ventilation and dehumidification must be provided by a complementary air delivery system. Air delivery systems that promote fully stratified or partially mixed air distribution when in cooling mode are often preferred, because passive beams mounted high operate more efficiently in thermally stratified environments.

Additional information on active and passive beams can be found in Woollett and Rimmer (2014) and Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

3.9 AIR CURTAIN UNITS

Air curtain units (ACUs) are local devices that supply high-velocity planar airstreams that act as controlled barriers for environmental and thermal separation, as well as for resisting wind when a building's doors or windows are open.

When used as an environmental separation barrier, an ACU minimizes migration of gaseous or particulate contaminants, deters flying insects, and may convey contaminants toward local exhaust. As a thermal barrier, the ACU reduces cross migration of warm, lighter air flowing through the upper part of the opening and cold, heavier air flowing through the lower part of the opening. As a wind resistance barrier, it minimizes the effect of outdoor air blowing into a building's openings.

An ACU can reduce the energy consumption of HVAC systems when areas of different temperatures need separating, but physical barriers such as walls or doors cannot be used at certain or all times. ACU energy effectiveness is defined by the amount of energy saved (i.e., the energy loss through an opening prevented with an ACU) divided by the amount of energy that would have been lost without, represented as a percentage. The cost effectiveness can be calculated similarly. Research has demonstrated that air curtains can range in energy effectiveness from 60 to 90%, depending on the type of unit and application (Costa et al. 2006; Giráldez et al. 2013). See Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information.

ACUs are constructed of a motor and fan, or a system of motors and fans, mounted inside a cabinet, and a specialized plenum for discharge. Air is drawn in through either a ducted or nonducted intake, specified with or without a filter, and discharged at a high velocity as an air curtain; this air curtain is sometimes referred to as the **ACU airstream**. The unit is normally mounted above or beside a door or window opening. Discharge across the opening is either vertical, when the unit is mounted above the opening, or horizontal, when the unit is mounted beside the opening. Due to fluid mechanics, air is entrained and mixed, from both sides, into the curtain. Thus, the direction of the jet produced is important, and is often adjustable or even actively controlled.

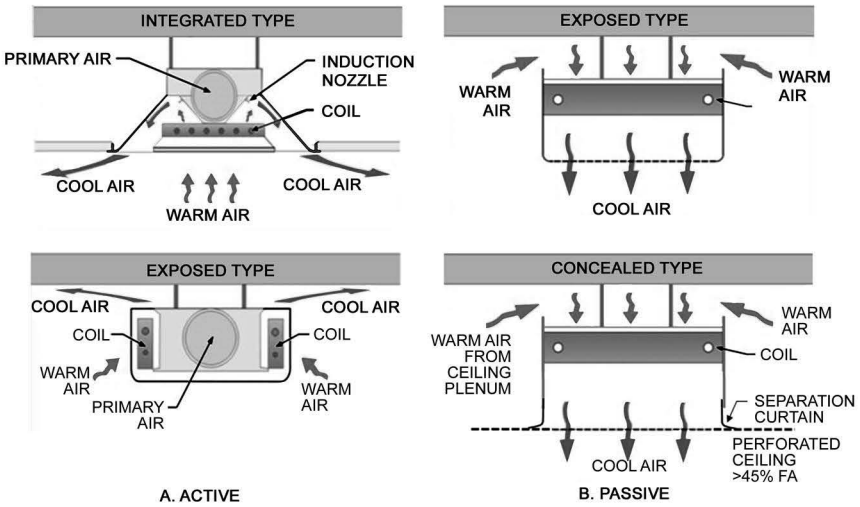

Fig. 10 (A) Active and (B) Passive Beams

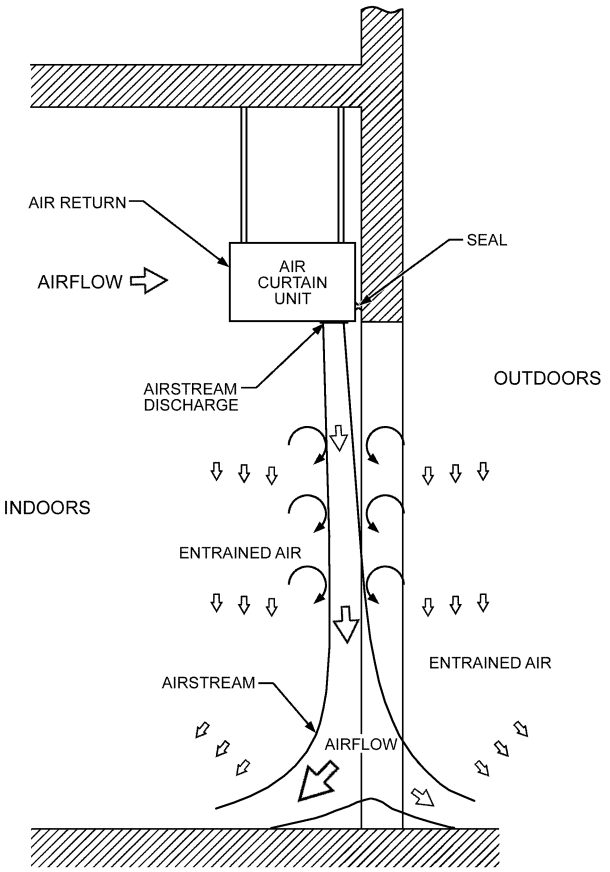

Fig. 11 Non-Recirculating, Horizontal-Mount High-Velocity Air Curtain Unit

(*Source*: AMCA *Standard* 222)

Unit Types and Configurations. ACUs are classified by two different types of construction: non-recirculating and recirculating. The major differences between the two systems are the airflow path, cabinet construction, range of effectiveness, and purchase and installation costs.

A **non-recirculating system** draws air into the unit directly from typically one indoor environment and is available in both horizontal and vertical applications; horizontal-mount, vertical-down discharge is depicted in Figure 11. An air curtain equipped with inlet ductwork that draws air from outdoors only is also considered to be nonrecirculating. This configuration is recommended for doorways that open frequently (e.g., 10 times or more per hour). Flying insect control applications use this type of unit exclusively because of its ability to generate a high-velocity airstream. It is the most common system for environmental separation because of its low initial purchase and installation costs. Nonrecirculating systems are typically used for special applications, due to their flexibility in construction and installation.

A **recirculating system** draws air from ductwork, which collects and returns much of the discharge air as well as entrained air to the ACU's inlet as shown in Figure 12. Applications often use a plenum with a floor return grille that is connected to the ACU's inlet with ductwork. An alternative construction includes horizontal flow, which discharges and returns from side to side. These systems are recommended for doorways that are opened for extended periods of time, with a high rate of traffic. Although its effectiveness rating is higher, this system is only suitable for thermal separation applications. Recirculating systems use lower velocities and are perceived as less obtrusive than non-recirculating systems.

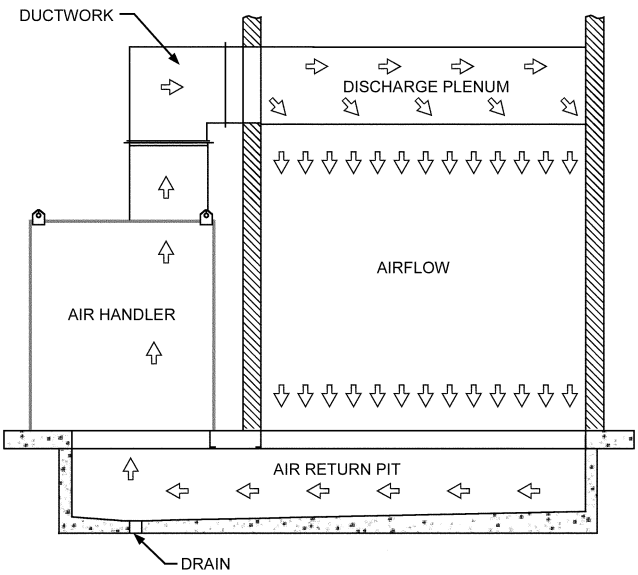

Fig. 12 Recirculating, Horizontal-Mount Air Curtain Unit

(*Source*: AMCA *Standard* 222)

Non-recirculating systems are normally self-contained systems that can be easily installed or retrofitted to existing openings with minimal planning and changes to the opening and its sequence of operation. Recirculating systems require preplanning and comprise a combination of components, including discharge and return plenums, which require integration into the construction of the opening and its sequence of operation.

The typical range of energy effectiveness for non-recirculating systems is 60 to 80%, whereas recirculating systems range between 80 to 90% (Costa et al. 2006; Giráldez et al. 2013). Non-recirculating systems also have a relatively low purchase and installation cost; recirculating systems can have significantly higher installed cost.

Optional features available for both ACU types include heating, cooling, filters, and special controls. Special casing materials and/or coatings may be required for outdoor mounting or harsh environmental applications.

The availability of integrated heating and/or cooling options depends on the intended application and cabinet construction requirements. Note that a heating or cooling option will not improve the air curtain's effectiveness; this serves as an enhancement to the application, independent of the protection provided by the airstream. A heat source may be added for local supplemental heat to reduce the windchill effect of the air curtain.

The most common heating types are

- Electric heating coils: open (helical) or fin-tube element
- Hydronic coil: hot water or steam
- Indirect gas-fired: furnace uses heat exchanger to separate combustion air from heated air curtain
- Direct gas-fired: burner fires directly into airstream being heated, so may not be acceptable for certain occupancies
- DX evaporator coil: direct-expansion vapor compression refrigeration cycle system

Cooling options are used for the same general reasons as the heating options: occupant comfort, supplemental cooling, or dehumidifying. Special care is needed in cooling applications to remove the condensate generated in the cooling apparatus, also accounting

for the higher face velocities across the coil so as not to blow water droplets off the coil. The most common types are

- Hydronic coil: chilled water
- DX evaporator coil: direct-expansion vapor compression refrigeration cycle system

Factors That Influence Selection. ACUs are typically considered for four different applications:

- Energy savings: indoor applications where doors or windows are used for pedestrian traffic or the transporting of goods where they would be open long enough to impact the designed load of the HVAC system. Examples include front or customer entry doors, loading docks, service windows, ovens, and coolers or freezers.
- Insect control (sanitation): indoor applications where doors or unscreened open windows could allow entrance of flying insects that would create an unsanitary environment.
- Code requirements: buildings that are being constructed to meet a jurisdictional code requirement.
- Process/special application: applications where the separation of two distinct environments is required to prevent cross contamination, fume/odor control, or a process that requires a direct stream of air to accomplish a specified task. Examples include cleanrooms, car washes, and assembly line drying or cooling by convection.

Chapter 58 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* provides details on these categories.

Product Selection. ACU selection depends on the width of the opening and installation height. To maximize effectiveness, the ACU must cover at a minimum the entire opening, and if possible should slightly overlap the opening's frame. On wide openings, two vertically mounted, low-air-velocity units can be used as an alternate solution to a single horizontally mounted, high-air-velocity unit. The ACU discharge must have a free and clear path to the entire opening for optimal performance.

Recent studies suggest that the minimum air velocity required at the floor to create an effective barrier is 2 m/s (Yang et al. 2019). When selecting air curtains, commercially available products are offered and designed specifically based on the opening size and application. Manufacturers' performance data should be consulted to determine the suitability of the ACUs used. Data to determine ACU performance should be obtained from recognized test standards such as ANSI/AMCA *Standard* 220.

Controls. ACU controls are essential to provide the correct air curtain velocity, temperature, and depth. They are also used to prevent unnecessary energy usage and overconditioning or overpressurizing the building entrance. Although supplemental heating and/or cooling can be provided by a so-equipped air curtain unit, it should not be seen as the primary source for conditioning internal areas. If an ACU is used for supplemental heating or cooling, the energy consumed during these control sequences should not be considered in the effectiveness rating of the unit. For convenience, user-operated controls are typically unit-mounted and configured to satisfy the building occupants' needs. To meet design, access, or security requirements, optional remote-mounted controls may be available. At the simplest level of control, only manual operation of the fan speed and heat output may be required. However, additional control options include

- Room thermostat
- Door contact switch
- Timer
- Step or modulating control of electric or water heating
- BMS control interface

The control unit may also have outputs for signaling failures or provide communication between the ACUs and the central control system (e.g., BMS, BAS, emergency management system [EMS]). ACUs can be equipped with controls as simple as a mechanical multispeed switch, or as sophisticated as an integrated interface with a touchpad or LCD panel. The LCD panel can control values such as discharge speed, heating/cooling status, indoor/outdoor set-point temperatures, failure reporting, and filter contamination level.

Maintenance. ACUs typically require biannual maintenance, depending on the application. Some designs may have motors and bearings that require periodic lubrication. Many designs use permanently sealed bearings instead. ACUs require only occasional cleaning of the blower impeller(s), cabinet interior, and heating apparatus, as well as filter cleaning or replacement if so equipped.

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CHAPTER 21

FANS

Types of Fans 21.1
Principles of Operation 21.1
Testing and Rating 21.6
Field Testing of Fans for Air Performance 21.6
Fan Laws 21.6
Fan and System Pressure Relationships 21.7
Air Temperature Rise Across Fans 21.8
Duct System Characteristics 21.8
System Effects 21.9
Selection 21.10
Parallel Fan Operation 21.11
Series Fan Operation 21.12
Noise 21.12
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Arrangement and Installation 21.13
Fan Control 21.13
Fan Inlet Cone Instrumented for Airflow Measurement 21.14
Fan Terminology 21.14
Symbols 21.17

A FAN uses a power-driven rotating impeller to move air or gas. The internal energy increase imparted by a fan to air or gas is limited to 25 kJ/kg. This limit is approximately equivalent to a total pressure rise of 30 kPa.

1. TYPES OF FANS

Fans are generally classified as centrifugal, axial, mixed flow, or cross flow according to the direction of airflow through the impeller. Figure 1 shows the general configuration of a housed centrifugal fan. The components of an axial-flow fan are shown in Figure 2.

Unhoused centrifugal fan impellers are used as circulators in some industrial applications (e.g., heat-treating ovens) and are identified as plug fans. In this case, there is no duct connection to the fan because it simply circulates the air within the oven. In some HVAC installations, the unhoused fan impeller is located in a plenum chamber with the fan inlet connected to an inlet duct or cone. This fan arrangement is identified as a plenum fan. Table 1 compares typical characteristics of some of the most common fan types. For definitions of common fan terms, see the section on Fan Terminology at the end of this chapter.

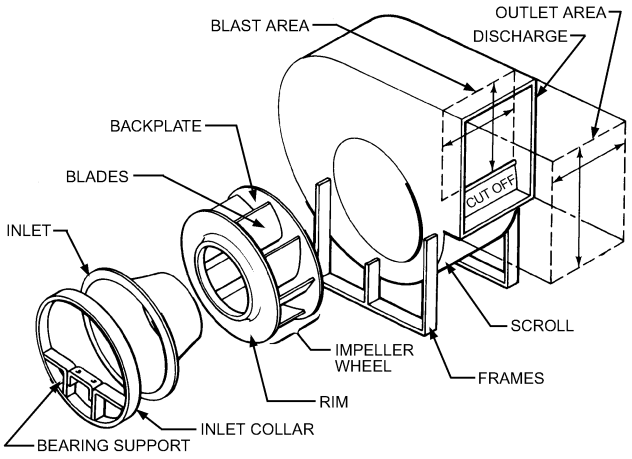


Fig. 1 Centrifugal Fan Components

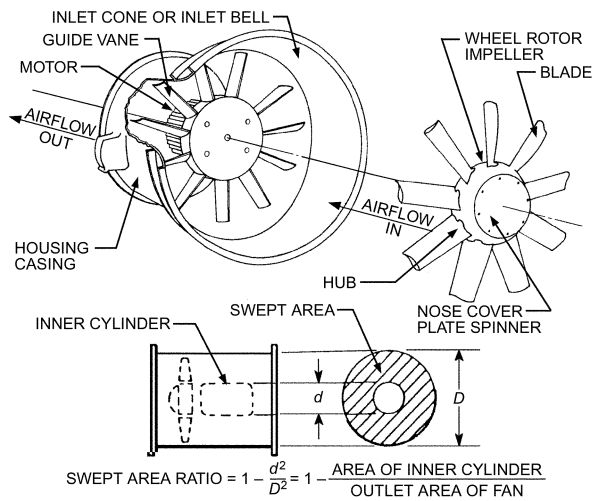
Source: Adapted from AMCA *Publication* 201-02, Fans and Systems, with written permission from Air Movement and Control Association International, Inc.

2. PRINCIPLES OF OPERATION

All fans produce pressure by altering the airflow's velocity vector. Velocity change is in the tangential and radial velocity directions for centrifugal fans, and in the axial and tangential velocity directions for axial-flow fans.

Centrifugal fan impellers increase pressure of air flowing through them by (1) centrifugal force created by rotating the air column between the blades and (2) kinetic energy imparted to the air by its velocity leaving the impeller. This velocity is a combination of rotational velocity of the impeller and airspeed relative to the impeller. When the blades are inclined forward, these two velocities are cumulative; when backward, oppositional. Fans with backward-curved blades are generally more efficient than ones with forward-curved blades.

Axial fan impellers increase pressure principally by the change in air velocity as it passes through the impeller blades, with none being produced by centrifugal force. These fans are divided into three types: propeller, tubeaxial, and vaneaxial. **Propeller** fans are nonducted fans customarily used at or near free air delivery, usually having a small-hub-to-tip-ratio impeller mounted in a fan panel, orifice plate, or inlet ring. Tubeaxial fans usually have reduced blade tip clearance and operate at higher tip speeds, giving them a higher pressure capability than the propeller fan. Vaneaxial fans are essentially tubeaxial fans with guide vanes and reduced blade tip clearance, which results in improved pressure, efficiency, and noise characteristics.



Note: The swept area ratio in axial fans is equivalent to the blast area ratio in centrifugal fans.

Fig. 2 Axial Fan Components

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 5.1, Fans.

Table 1 Types of Fans

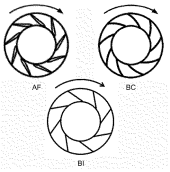
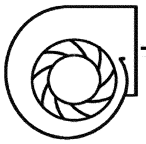
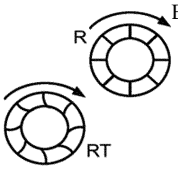
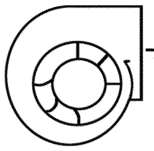
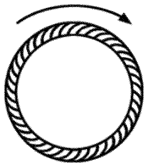
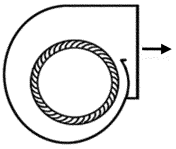
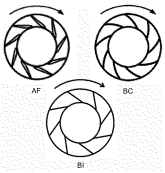
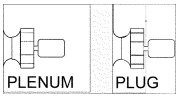
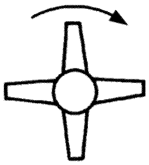
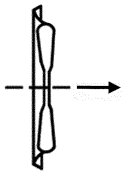
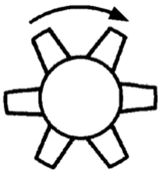
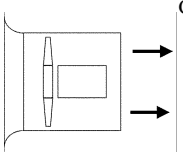
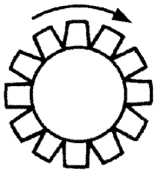
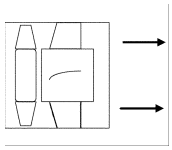
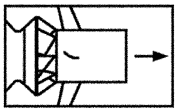
	Type	Impeller Design	Housing Design
Centrifugal Fans	Backward-Inclined (includes AF, BC, and BI)	 Blades inclined away from direction of rotation and can be single-thickness flat (BI), single-thickness curved (BC), or airfoil (AF) contour. Deep blades allow efficient expansion in blade passages. Air leaves impeller at velocity less than tip speed. For given duty, has highest speed of centrifugal fan designs.	 Single- or double-inlet scroll design for efficient conversion of tangential velocity pressure to static pressure. Maximum efficiency requires close clearance and alignment between impeller and inlet.
	Radial and Radial Tipped	 Blades are either fully radial (R) or backward inclined with a radial curve at outer edge (RT). Fully radial blades can have back plate and shroud, back plate only, or neither (open). Radial tipped blades normally have back plate and shroud.	 Single or double inlet scroll similar to other centrifugal fan designs. Fit between impeller and inlet not as critical as for backward inclined fans.
	Forward-Curved	 Large number of thin curved blades with outer edge tipped toward direction of rotation. Air leaves impeller with a high tangential velocity. Relies on scroll housing to convert this velocity pressure to static pressure. For given duty, has lowest speed of centrifugal fan designs.	 Single or double inlet scroll shaped design necessary for conversion of tangential velocity pressure to static pressure. Fit between impeller and inlet not as critical as for backward inclined fans.
	Plenum/ Plug	 Single inlet centrifugal impellers can be airfoil, backward curved, or backward inclined. Mixed flow or radial impellers can also be used for specific applications.	 No integral housing. The equivalent of a housing, or plenum chamber (dashed line), depends on the application. Due to the lack of a housing, all pressure development occurs in the impeller. The components of the drive system for the plug fan are located outside the airstream.
Axial Fans	Propeller	 Small number of blades (two to six), either airfoil or single thickness curved, attached to a relatively small hub.	 Simple circular ring, orifice plate, or venturi. Optimum design is close to blade tips and forms smooth airflow into impeller. Improved static efficiency can be obtained with an extension of the venturi into an expanding conical discharge.
	Tubeaxial	 Usually has four to eight blades with airfoil or single thickness cross section. Blades may have fixed or adjustable pitch. Hub is usually less than half the fan tip diameter.	 Cylindrical tube with close clearance to blade tips. Free inlet applications should use a bell mouth inlet to minimize entrance losses.
	Vaneaxial	 Typically has more blades than tubeaxial fans. Blades may have fixed, adjustable, or controllable pitch. Hub is usually greater than half fan tip diameter. Most efficient designs have airfoil blades.	 Cylindrical tube with close clearance to blade tips. Guide vanes upstream or downstream from impeller increase pressure capability and efficiency.
Mixed-Flow	Mixed-Flow	Combination of axial and centrifugal characteristics. Contoured back or hub; airfoil, curved, or straight blades, either shrouded or not. Airflow through impeller has both radial and axial components.	 The majority of mixed-flow fans have a tubular housing for use in ducted applications and include outlet turning vanes.

Table 1 Types of Fans (*Continued*)

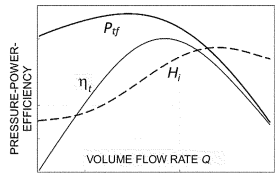
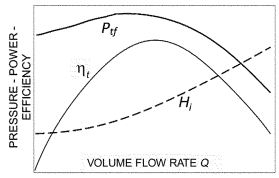
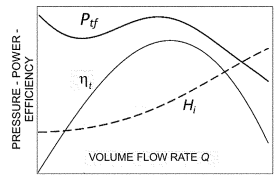
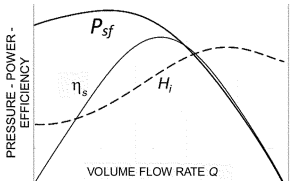
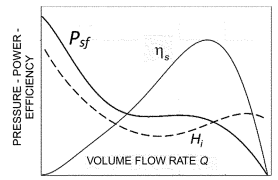
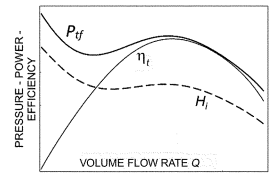
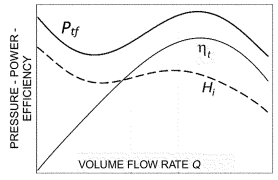
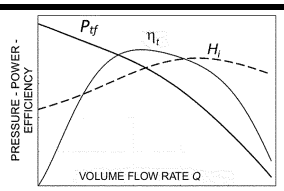
Performance Curves*	Performance Characteristics	Applications
	Highest efficiency of all centrifugal fan designs, with peak efficiencies occurring at 50 to 60% of wide-open volume. Fan has a non-overloading characteristic, which means power reaches maximum near peak efficiency and becomes lower, or self-limiting, toward free delivery. Airfoil blades are most efficient, followed by curved and then flat blades.	General HVAC. Used in ducted applications covering a large range of pressures. Airfoil blades can be used for clean air industrial operations. For industrial applications where the environment may corrode or erode airfoil blades, consider using single thickness blades instead.
	Higher pressure characteristics than airfoil and backward curved fans. Power rises continually to free delivery, which is an overloading characteristic. Radial tipped blades are slightly more efficient than straight blades. Shrouded impellers are more efficient than nonshrouded.	Primarily for material handling in industrial plants where high duct velocities are required to keep materials airborne. Also for some high-pressure industrial requirements. Rugged impeller is simple to repair in the field. Choice of impeller type generally depends on materials being transported. Impeller sometimes coated with special material.
	Pressure curve less steep than that of backward-inclined fans. Curve dips to left of peak pressure. Highest efficiency occurs at 40 to 50% of wide open volume. Operate fan to right of peak pressure. Power rises continually to free delivery which is an overloading characteristic.	Primarily for low- to medium-pressure HVAC applications, such as residential furnaces, central station units, and packaged air conditioners. Slower speed and lower tonal noise characteristics allow them to be used closer to occupied spaces. A possible exception is central station air handling units because of low frequency noise that is more difficult to attenuate.
	Similar to housed airfoil/backward curved/backward inclined fans but slightly less efficient due to the lack of conversion of kinetic energy in the discharge airstream. Because plenum and plug fans do not have usable outlet velocity pressure, they should always be selected based on fan static pressure. Both fans are susceptible to performance degradation caused by poor inlet installation and insufficient clearance to surrounding	Plenum fans are used for HVAC equipment such as air handlers. Advantages include flexibility of equipment discharge and potential for smaller equipment footprint. Multiple plenum fans in parallel (fan arrays) can be used to further reduce the axial length of air handling equipment. Plug fans are commonly used for high-temperature process applications.
	High flow rate, but very low pressure capabilities. Discharge pattern circular or conical and airstream swirls.	For low-pressure, high-volume air-moving applications, such as ventilation through a wall without ductwork or air-cooled condenser fans.
	High flow rate, medium pressure capabilities. Pressure curve can dip to left of peak pressure at higher blade pitches. Avoid operating fan in this stall region. Discharge pattern circular and airstream rotates or swirls downstream of fan.	Low- and medium-pressure ducted HVAC applications where straight through flow and compact installation are required. Used in some industrial applications, such as drying ovens, paint spray booths, and fume exhausts.
	High pressure characteristics with medium volume flow capabilities. Pressure curve can dip to left of peak pressure. Avoid operating fan in this stall region. Guide vanes correct circular motion imparted by impeller, which improves pressure characteristics and fan efficiency.	General HVAC systems in medium- and high-pressure applications where straight-through flow and compact installation are required. Has swirl-free downstream airflow. Used in industrial applications in place of tubeaxial fans. More compact than centrifugal fans for same duty.
	Characteristic pressure curve between axial fans and centrifugal fans. Higher pressure than axial fans and higher-volume flow than centrifugal fans.	Similar HVAC applications to centrifugal fans or in applications where an axial fan cannot generate sufficient pressure rise.

Table 1 Types of Fans (*Concluded*)

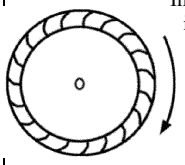
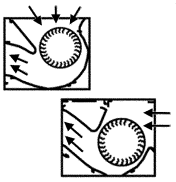
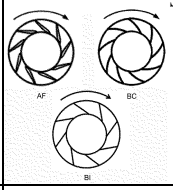
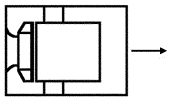
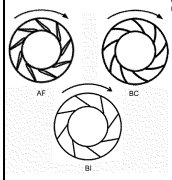
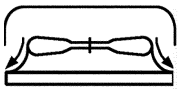
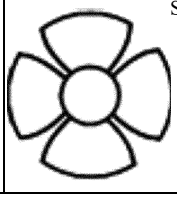
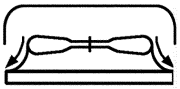
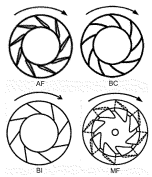
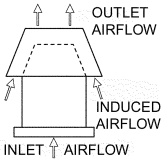
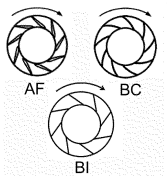
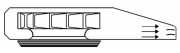
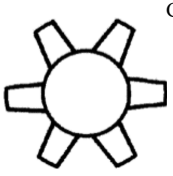
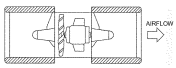
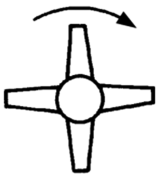
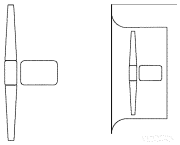
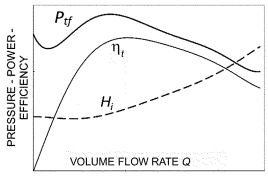
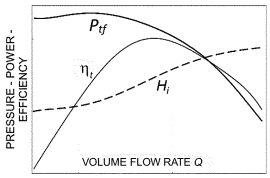
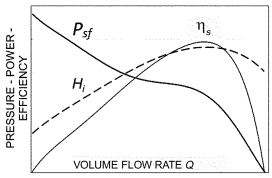
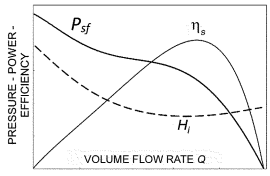
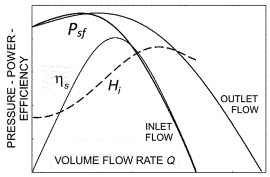
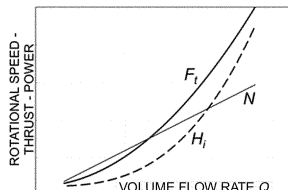
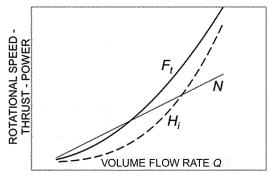
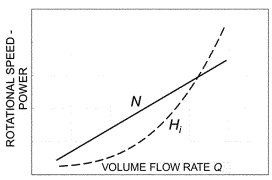
	Type		Impeller Design	Housing Design
Cross-flow	Cross-flow (Tangential)		 Impeller with forward-curved blades. Typically impeller width is much greater than diameter.	 Specially designed housing for 90° or straight-through airflow. Housing causes air to enter the impeller at its periphery, flow through the impeller, and discharge at a different point of its periphery.
Other Designs	Inline Centrifugal		 Single-inlet centrifugal impellers can be airfoil, backward curved, or backward inclined.	 Cylindrical tube similar to vaneaxial fan, except clearance to impeller is not as close. Air discharges radially from impeller and turns 90° to flow through guide vanes. Variations include cylindrical and square housings with or without guide vanes. Square housings can include side discharge.
	Power Roof Ventilators	Centrifugal	 Single-inlet centrifugal impellers can be airfoil, backward curved, or backward inclined.	 Weather-protected housing with means of mounting to a building opening. Usually does not include configuration to recover velocity pressure component. Radial discharge from impeller can be directed either toward building or away from building.
		Axial	 Small number of blades (two to six), similar to an axial propeller fan.	 Similar housing to an axial propeller fan with added weather protection and means of mounting to a building opening. Can supply or exhaust air from a building, and housing can direct air either toward building or away from building.
	Induced-Flow Exhaust		 Centrifugal backward inclined or mixed flow.	 Can be scroll or tubular inline with converging cone or nozzle to increase nozzle velocity, which induces additional airflow through outlet.
	Jet Fan	Centrifugal	 Single-inlet centrifugal impellers can be airfoil, backward curved, or backward inclined.	 Rectangular, low profile. Outlet tapers to increase discharge velocity. May contain outlet straighteners and inlet protection guards.
		Axial	 Could be bidirectional or reversible in operation; similar flow rates in either direction is common.	 Tubular housing may or may not have guide vanes. Typically fitted with inlet and outlet silencers and protection screens.
		Circulating	 Includes small propeller fans up to large-diameter ceiling mounted fans. Typically two to eight blades, either airfoil or single-thickness curved, attached to a comparatively small-diameter hub.	 Often unhoused, but can have housing.

Table 1 Types of Fans (*Concluded*)

Performance Curves*	Performance Characteristics	Applications
	Similar to forward-curved fans. Power rises continually to free delivery, which is an overloading characteristic. Lowest efficiency of any centrifugal fan type.	Low-pressure HVAC components (e.g., fan heaters, fireplace inserts, electronic cooling, air curtains) where a long, narrow discharge is needed.
	Performance similar to backward-inclined fan, except capacity and pressure are lower. Lower efficiency than backward-inclined fan because air turns 90°.	Ducted HVAC applications with air discharging in axial direction (e.g., low- to medium-pressure return air systems in HVAC applications).
	Less efficient than scroll-type housed fan. Centrifugal units are slightly quieter than axial units.	Low-pressure ducted exhaust systems (e.g., general factory, kitchen, warehouse, some commercial installations).
	Usually installed without ductwork; therefore, operates at very low pressure and high volume.	Low-pressure exhaust or supply systems (e.g., general factory, kitchen, warehouse, some commercial installations).
	Performance similar to BI and MF but with reduced efficiency due to high velocity needed for induction. Outlet airflow greater than inlet airflow.	Typically used for laboratory or hazardous chemical exhaust where dilution is required and tall stacks are not desired.
	Performance measured and rated in thrust F_t. Designed for high-velocity discharge to add momentum to larger volume of air. Note that performance curves shown are not at a single speed, but at variable speeds N.	Unducted for space-constrained parking garages and emergency fire and smoke evacuation. Comparable initial cost with ducted solutions but more flexibility for exhaust and inlet air locations.
	Performance measured and rated in thrust F_t. Designed for high-velocity discharge to add momentum to larger volume of air. Typically operates at high speed, which necessitates inlet and outlet silencers. Note that performance curves shown are not at a single speed, but at variable speeds N.	Road or rail tunnels, parking garages, and emergency fire and smoke evacuation. Comparable initial cost with ducted solutions but more flexibility for the exhaust and inlet air locations.
	Performance typically measured and rated in airflow rate versus input power and impeller rotational speed N. Usually operated at free air with high-volume flow rate. Note that performance curves shown are not at a single speed, but at variable speeds.	Used for generating elevated air speeds to provide cooling of people or animals and prevent stratification of temperature or humidity (e.g., inside warehouses, airports, gymnasiums, barns). Can also be used for drying processes.

*These performance curves reflect general characteristics of various fans as commonly applied. They are not intended to provide complete selection criteria, because other parameters, such as diameter and speed, are not defined.

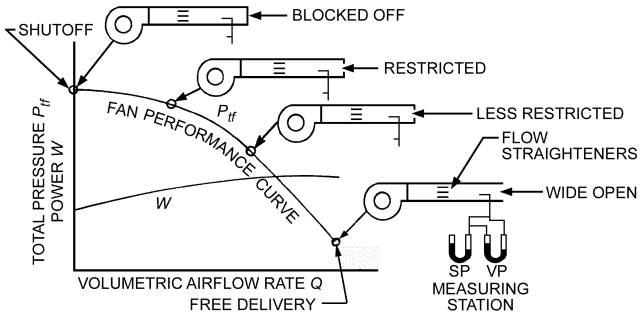


Fig. 3 Method of Obtaining Fan Performance Curves

Table 1 includes typical performance curves for various types of fans. These curves (unless otherwise stated in the table) show the general total or static pressure Pt_f of P_{sf}, total or static efficiency η_f or η_s, and fan input power H_i characteristics of various fans at a single constant operating speed as they are normally used. They do not reflect fan characteristics reduced to common denominators such as constant speed or constant propeller diameter, because fans are not selected on the basis of these constants. A particular fan (size, speed) must be selected by evaluating actual characteristics.

3. TESTING AND RATING

ASHRAE *Standard* 51 (AMCA *Standard* 210) specifies procedures and test setups to be used in laboratory testing fans and other air-moving devices. The most common type of test uses multiple nozzle inlet or outlet chambers. Figure 3 shows a pitot-static tube traverse procedure for developing characteristics of a fan. Fan performance is determined from free delivery conditions to shutoff conditions. At free delivery, outlet resistance is reduced to zero; at shutoff, the fan is completely blocked off. Between these two conditions, an auxiliary fan and various airflow restrictions are used to simulate various operating conditions on the fan. Enough points are obtained to define the curve between free air delivery and shutoff conditions. For each case, the specific point on the curve must be defined by referring to the airflow rate and corresponding fan total or static pressure. Other test setups described in ASHRAE *Standard* 51 should produce a similar performance curve, within the limits of each setup.

Fans designed for use with duct systems are tested with a length of duct between the fan and measuring station. The length of duct evens out the air velocity profile discharged from the fan outlet to provide stable, uniform airflow conditions at the plane of measurement. Pressure losses of the ductwork and flow straightener between the fan outlet and the plane of measurement are added to the measured pressure at the plane of measurement to determine the actual fan performance. Fans designed for use without ducts, including almost all propeller fans and power roof ventilators, are tested without ductwork.

Not all fan sizes are tested for rating. Test information and the fan laws may be used to calculate performance of geometrically similar larger fans, but such information should not be extrapolated to smaller fans. Test information and the fan laws can also be used to calculate performance at other speeds. To determine performance of one fan using the known performance of another, the two fans must be geometrically, kinematically, and dynamically similar. Strict similarity requires that the important nondimensional parameters (those that affect aerodynamic characteristics, e.g., Mach number, Reynolds number, surface roughness, gap size) vary in only insignificant ways. For more specific information, consult the manufacturer's application manual, engineering data, or Howden Buffalo (1999).

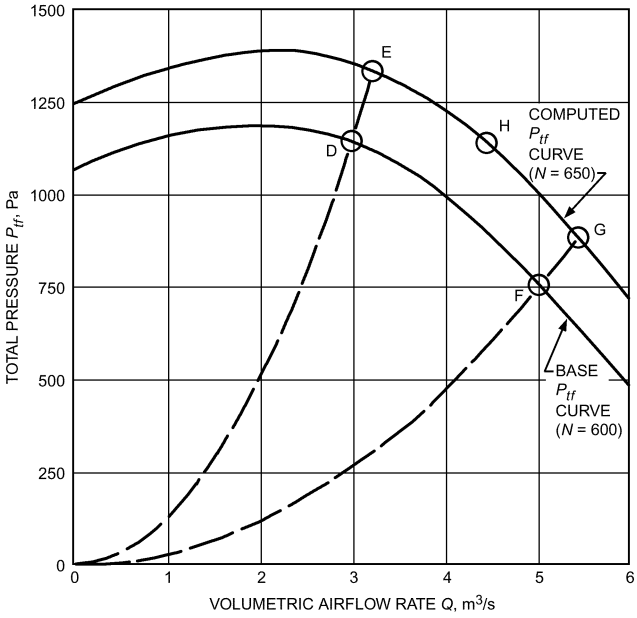


Fig. 4 Example Application of Fan Laws

4. FIELD TESTING OF FANS FOR AIR PERFORMANCE

Aerodynamic performance of a fan as installed almost always differs from the performance determined by laboratory testing. Performance differences primarily derive from system configuration differences between the field and laboratory setup, such as added elbows, obstructions in the path of the airflow, and sudden changes of duct cross-sectional area in the field installation.

Because of the performance differences, it is sometimes necessary to determine a fan's in situ performance. Typical reasons include the following:

- A general fan system evaluation to be used as the basis for modifying or adjusting fan drive components or the system to which the fan is attached
- A fan acceptance test (FAT) per specification in a sales agreement to verify quoted fan performance
- A proof of performance test in response to a complaint to demonstrate fan performance

In North America, most general fan system evaluations in the field can be accomplished using the guidelines outlined in AMCA *Publication* 203. When field testing is required and more accurate results are needed to meet a stringent contract, AMCA *Standard* 803 or ASME *Code* PTC 11 is often used. In Europe and other areas of the world, ISO *Standard* 5802 is sometimes used. Because finding a suitable flow measurement plane can often be difficult in the field, it is highly recommended to include provisions for a calibrated flow measuring station near the fan inlet and/or outlet or pressure ports on the fan as part of system design.

5. FAN LAWS

The classical form of the fan laws (see Table 2) relate performance variables for any geometrically, kinematically, and dynamically similar fans. They are a simplification of the generalized fan laws (Sardar 2001) in that they ignore Reynolds number effects. The variables are fan size D, rotational speed N, gas density ρ, volume

Table 2 Fan Laws

Law No.	Dependent Variables				Independent Variables
1a	Q_1	=	Q_2	×	$(D_1/D_2)^3(N_1/N_2)$
1b	P_1	=	P_2	×	$(D_1/D_2)^2(N_1/N_2)^2\rho_1/\rho_2$
1c	W_1	=	W_2	×	$(D_1/D_2)^5(N_1/N_2)^3\rho_1/\rho_2$
2a	Q_1	=	Q_2	×	$(D_1/D_2)^2(P_1/P_2)^{1/2}(\rho_2/\rho_1)^{1/2}$
2b	N_1	=	N_2	×	$(D_2/D_1)(P_1/P_2)^{1/2}(\rho_2/\rho_1)^{1/2}$
2c	W_1	=	W_2	×	$(D_1/D_2)^2(P_1/P_2)^{3/2}(\rho_2/\rho_1)^{1/2}$
3a	N_1	=	N_2	×	$(D_2/D_1)^3(Q_1/Q_2)$
3b	P_1	=	P_2	×	$(D_2/D_1)^4(Q_1/Q_2)^2\rho_1/\rho_2$
3c	W_1	=	W_2	×	$(D_2/D_1)^4(Q_1/Q_2)^3\rho_1/\rho_2$

Notes:
1. Subscript 1 denotes fan under consideration. Subscript 2 denotes tested fan.
2. For all fan laws $(\eta_t)_1 = (\eta_t)_2$ and (Point of rating)$_1$ = (Point of rating)$_2$.
3. P equals either P_{vf}, P_{tf}, or P_{sf}.
4. See Howden Buffalo (1999) for other considerations (e.g., compressibility effects are typically ignored for fan total pressure rises of less than 2500 Pa).

airflow rate Q, pressure P_{tf} or P_{sf}, impeller input power H, and total efficiency of the fan η_t. It is important to recognize that the fan laws only apply to fans and must not be used to calculate performance of other system components, such as drive belts, motors, or variable-frequency drives. More information about fan law deviations related to Reynolds number, Mach number, and bearing and drive losses can be found in Annex E of ASHRAE *Standard* 51-2016, Phelan et al. (1979), and Sardar (2001).

Fan Law 1 shows the effect of changing size, speed, or density on volume airflow rate, pressure, and power. **Fan Law 2** shows the effect of changing size, pressure, or density on volume airflow rate, speed, and power. **Fan Law 3** shows the effect of changing size, volume airflow rate, or density on speed, pressure, and power.

As indicated by the fan laws, fan performance is affected by gas density. Unless otherwise identified, fan performance data are based on dry air at standard conditions: 101.325 kPa and 20°C (1.20 kg/m^3). In actual applications, the fan may be required to handle air or gas at some other density. Changes in density may be caused by temperature, humidity, composition of the gas, or altitude. With constant size and speed, power and pressure vary in accordance with the ratio of gas density to standard air density.

Figure 4 shows application of the fan laws for a change in fan speed N for the same fan (i.e., $D_1 = D_2$). The computed P_{tf} curve is derived from the base curve. For example, point E ($N_1 = 650$) is computed from point D ($N_2 = 600$) as follows:

At point D,

$$Q_2 = 3 \text{ m}^3/\text{s and } P_{tf_2} = 1125 \text{ Pa}$$

Using Fan Law 1a at point E,

$$Q_1 = 3(650/600) = 3.25 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$$

Using Fan Law 1b ($\rho_1 = \rho_2$),

$$P_{tf_1} = 1125(650/600)^2 = 1320 \text{ Pa}$$

The total pressure curve P_{tf_1} at $N = 650$ rpm may be generated by computing additional points from data on the base curve, such as point G from point F.

If equivalent points of rating are joined, as shown by the dashed lines in Figure 4, they form parabolas, which are defined by the relationship expressed in Equation (2).

Each point on the base P_{tf} curve determines only one point on the computed curve. For example, point H cannot be calculated from either point D or point F. Point H is, however, related to some point between these two points on the base curve, and only that point can be used to locate point H. Furthermore, point D cannot be used to calculate point F on the base curve. The entire base curve must be defined by test.

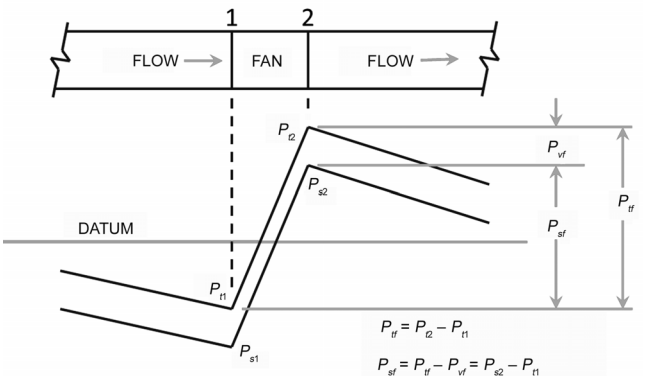


Fig. 5 Pressure Changes for Fan with Equal-Sized Ducted Inlet and Outlet Systems

6. FAN AND SYSTEM PRESSURE RELATIONSHIPS

Air traveling through a fan and air distribution system contains both static energy and kinetic energy. At any plane in the flow direction, these energies are represented by static pressure P_s and average velocity pressure P_v, respectively. Energy conversion occurs within the fan and distribution system, and is indicated by changes in static pressure to velocity pressure, and vice versa. Total pressure P_t at any plane, representing the total energy, is the sum of the static and velocity pressures. Although static and velocity pressures can increase of decrease with changes in cross-sectional area, total pressure always decreases in the direction of flow (except in the fan, where energy is added and total system pressure increases).

System pressure loss ΔP is the sum of all individual total pressure losses imposed by the air distribution system elements on both the inlet and outlet sides of the fan. Chapter 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* provides further information about airflow versus pressure relationships in air distribution systems. System pressure loss is not simply the sum of the static pressure losses in individual distribution system elements (e.g., ducts, coils, filters), except in special cases where air velocities are the same throughout all of the distribution system elements.

ASHRAE *Standard* 51-2016 describes laboratory methods of test to determine fan aerodynamic performance data, such as fan pressure versus airflow characteristics. The terminology used to describe fan pressures P_{tf}, P_{sf}, and P_{vf} and the applicability of those terms must be clearly understood. **Fan total pressure P_{tf}** is the difference between the total pressures at the fan outlet and inlet ($P_{t2} - P_{t1}$). In contrast, **fan static pressure P_{sf}** is the difference between the fan total pressure and the fan velocity pressure ($P_{tf} - P_{vf}$). Therefore, it is also the difference between the static pressure at the fan outlet and the total pressure at the fan inlet ($P_{s2} - P_{t1}$). Except in special cases, fan static pressure P_{sf} is not the measured difference between static pressures at the fan inlet and outlet planes ($P_{s2} - P_{s1}$).

Figures 5 to 7 depict pressure changes throughout various fan and system configurations. The datum line shown in these figures refers to zero pressure for a typical system. Figure 5 shows a fan with ducted inlet and outlet systems, and Figure 6 shows a fan with a ducted outlet system but no connected inlet system. An inlet bell may be required to achieve published fan performance in the absence of an inlet duct. In this case, published fan performance effectively extends from plane 0 to plane 2, and fan static pressure is equal to the static pressure rise across the fan and inlet bell. Finally, Figure 7 shows a fan with a ducted inlet system but no outlet system.

Fan selection (covered in detail in the section on Selection) involves, in part, matching the fan pressure capability with system pressure loss at a design condition (often at the maximum required airflow). For fan systems having ducted outlets (Figures 5 and 6), fan total pressure P_{tf} should be used for fan selection. For a fan without an outlet duct (Figure 7), however, fan static pressure P_{sf} should be used instead. In the latter case, the fan velocity pressure at the discharge dissipates immediately and cannot contribute to overcoming system resistance. Therefore, the fan static pressure P_{sf}, which is the static pressure at the fan outlet P_{s2} minus the total pressure at the fan inlet P_t1, is matched to the system pressure loss.

All systems shown in Figures 5 to 7 have inlet or outlet ducts that match the fan connections in size. Often, however, the duct size is not identical to the fan outlet or inlet, thus introducing a further complication. To illustrate pressure changes in this case, Figure 8 shows a diverging outlet cone, which is a common type of fan connection. Static pressure in the cone increases in the direction of airflow (**static regain**). The regain occurs because the cross-sectional area increases through the cone and the average velocity decreases correspondingly. The total pressure decreases slightly because the conversion from average velocity pressure to static pressure involves losses. As with the other two previous ducted-outlet systems, fan total pressure P_{tf} should be used for fan selection, and static pressure across the fan ($P_{s2} - P_{s1}$) does not equal the fan static pressure P_{sf}.

7. AIR TEMPERATURE RISE ACROSS FANS

In certain applications, it may be desirable to calculate the air temperature rise across the fan. For low pressure rises (<2.5 kPa), estimate the air temperature rise by

$$\Delta T = \frac{\Delta P}{\rho c_p \eta} \quad (1)$$

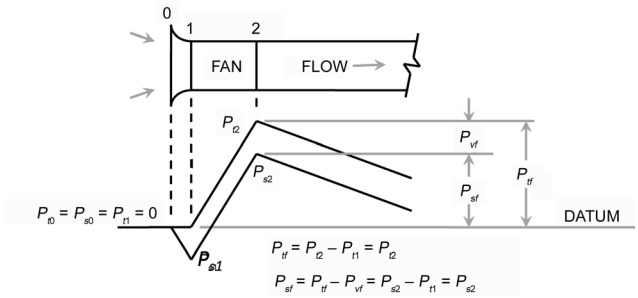


Fig. 6 Pressure Changes for Fan with Outlet System Only

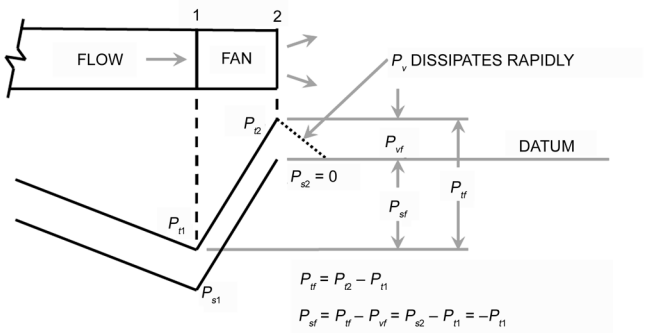


Fig. 7 Pressure Changes for Fan with Ducted Inlet System Only

where

ΔT = air temperature rise across fan, K
ΔP = pressure rise across fan, Pa
ρ = air density, kg/m^3
c_p = specific heat of air = 1005 J/(kg·K)
η = efficiency, decimal

If the motor is not in the airstream, efficiency is the fan total efficiency. If the motor and transmission (e.g., drive belt, if used) are in the airstream, the efficiency is instead the product of the motor, transmission, and fan efficiencies. It is important to recognize that fan, transmission, and motor efficiencies are not necessarily constant, and in many cases vary with the fraction of full-load operation.

Also, heat rejected by variable-frequency drives (if used, and usually not located in the airstream) and the fraction of motor and transmission heat not transferred to the airstream should be accounted for as building loads instead.

8. DUCT SYSTEM CHARACTERISTICS

Figure 9 shows a simplified duct system with three 90° elbows. These elbows represent the resistance offered by the ductwork and account for duct friction losses and fitting losses. A given airflow through a system requires a definite total pressure in the system. If the rate of airflow changes, the resulting total pressure required will vary (Equation [2], which is true for systems with no coils or filters [e.g., return or exhaust air systems]). HVAC systems such as these generally follow this law very closely.

$$(\Delta P_2 / \Delta P_1) = (Q_2 / Q_1)^2 \quad (2)$$

In some systems, particularly constant- or variable-volume air systems that include coils and filters and that may also control pres-

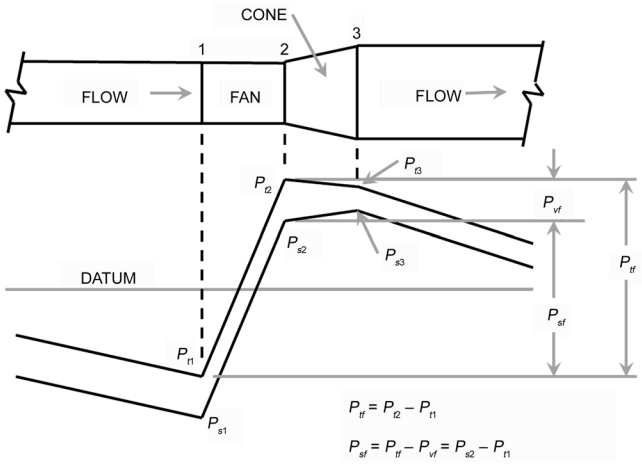


Fig. 8 Pressure Changes for Fan with Diverging Cone at Outlet

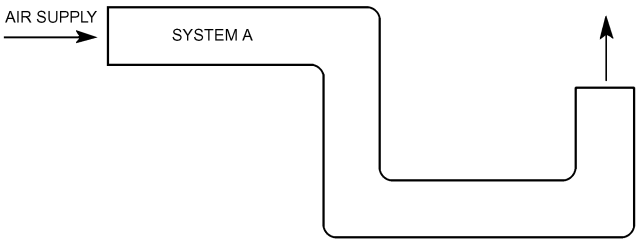


Fig. 9 Simple Duct System with Resistance to Flow Represented by Three 90° Elbows

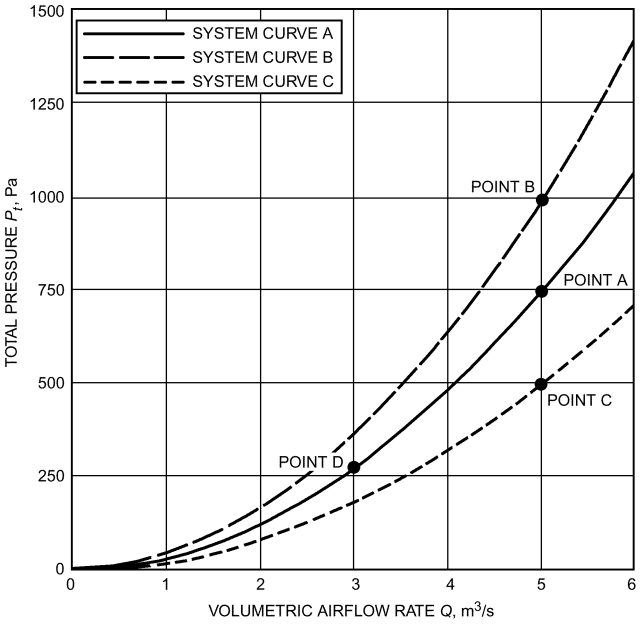


Fig. 10 Example System Total Pressure Loss ΔP Curves

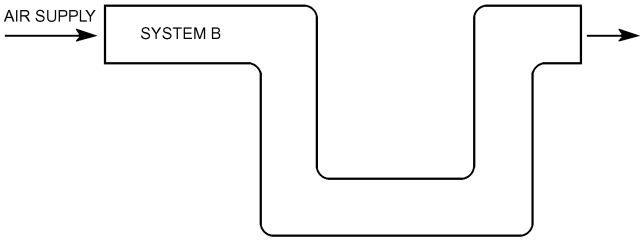


Fig. 11 Resistance Added to Duct System of Figure 9

sures at some points, the system resistance curves can deviate widely from Equation (2), even if many of the system elements are described by this equation. Sherman and Wray (2010) provide more details about these types of systems, including the effects of system leakage.

Equation (2) can plot this simple system's pressure loss ΔP curve from one known operating condition (see Figure 4). The fixed system must operate at some point on this simple quadratic system curve as the volume flow rate changes. For example, in Figure 10, at point A of system curve A, when the flow rate through a duct system such as that shown in Figure 9 is 5 m^3/s, the total pressure loss is 750 Pa. If these values are substituted in Equation (2) for ΔP_1 and Q_1, other points along the system curve (Figure 10) can be determined.

For 3 m^3/s (Point D in Figure 10):

$$\Delta P_2 = 750(3/5)^2 = 270 \text{ Pa}$$

If the system is changed so total pressure at the design flow rate is increased, the system will no longer operate on the previous system curve, and a new system curve will be defined.

For example, in Figure 11, an elbow added to the duct system shown in Figure 9 increases the total pressure loss of the system. If the total pressure loss at 5 m^3/s is increased by 250 Pa, the system total pressure loss at this point is now 1000 Pa, as shown by point B in Figure 10.

If the system in Figure 9 is changed by removing one of the elbows (Figure 12), the resulting system total pressure loss decreases, and the new system curve is curve C of Figure 10. For

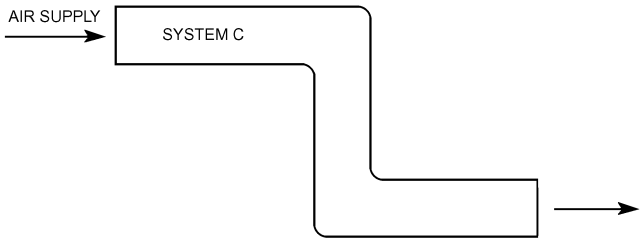


Fig. 12 Resistance Removed from Duct System of Figure 9

curve C, a total pressure loss of 250 Pa has been assumed when 5 m^3/s flows through the system; thus, the point of operation is at 500 Pa, as shown by point C.

The three system curves in Figure 10 follow the relationship expressed in Equation (2). These curves result from changes in the system itself and do not change the fan performance. During duct design, such system total pressure changes may occur because of alternative duct routing, differences in duct sizes, allowance for future duct extensions, or the design safety factor being applied to the system.

In an actual operating constant-air-volume system without coils or air filters, these three system curves can represent three system characteristic lines caused by three different positions of a throttling control damper. Curve C is the most open position, and curve B is the most closed. A control damper forms a continuous series of these system curves as it moves from wide open to completely closed and covers a much wider range of operation than is shown here. Note that pressure-independent throttling of VAV box dampers does not result in different system curves (Sherman and Wray 2010).

9. SYSTEM EFFECTS

A fan is normally tested under one of several standardized laboratory conditions (e.g., wide-open inlet and a long, straight duct attached to the outlet), which result in uniform flow into the fan and efficient static pressure recovery on the fan outlet. When a fan is installed in an application, laboratory conditions are usually not preserved. Typically, inlet and outlet conditions in installations are not the same as in the testing environment, because the fan discharges to a plenum, the discharge or intake side of the fan is too close to a transition (change in area and direction of flow) or wall, or any other interference in the flow field. This difference affects the actual fan performance.

The adverse influences of system connections on fan performance are commonly called **system effects**. To select and apply the fan properly, the system effects must be considered and the pressure requirements of the fan, as calculated by duct design procedures, must be increased accordingly. More importantly, because of the huge potential pressure (and thus energy) losses associated with system effects, great care should be taken in actual air system design and installation to eliminate or minimize system effects.

The magnitudes of system effects are typically characterized by **system effect factors**, which are values (usually in terms of pressure) suggested to compensate for the system effects. ASHRAE's (2012) *Duct Fitting Database* provides information on converting system effect factors into loss coefficients so that they can be combined with other duct losses. AMCA *Publication* 201 provides further information on determining system effect factors for various conditions. These calculated system effect factors are only an approximation, however. Fans of different types, and even fans of the same type but supplied by different manufacturers, do not necessarily react to a system in the same way. Therefore, judgment based on experience must be applied to air system design.

To provide improved knowledge and additional test data on system effects, ASHRAE completed a series of research projects to study the inlet system effects on both air and sound for different types of fans. Conclusions from these research projects include the following:

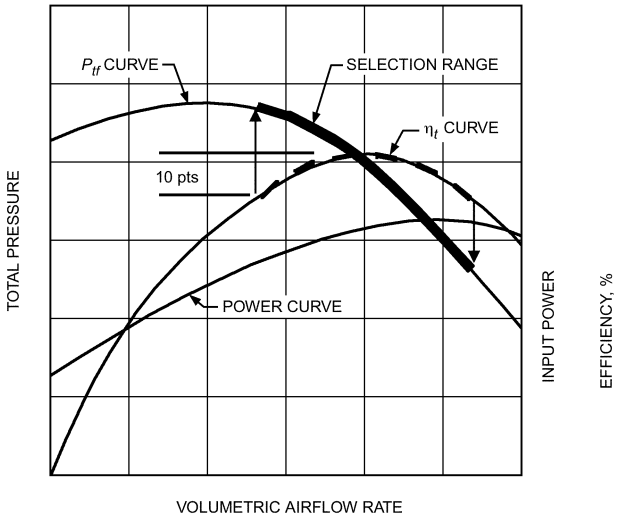
- Substantial system effects will be induced if the distance between the fan inlet and the cabinet wall is less than 0.5 times the impeller diameter; hence, this layout should be avoided as much as possible in actual system design and installation.
- System effects on sound caused by poor inlet conditions are very pronounced but also difficult to quantify.

More details are provided by Darvennes et al. (2008), Stevens and Schubert (2010), and Swim (1997). ASHRAE research projects RP-1216 and RP-1420 (Guedel et al. 2011, 2014) also provide further information on inlet and discharge installation effects on airfoil centrifugal fans.

10. SELECTION

After the system pressure loss curve of the air distribution system has been defined, a fan can be selected to meet the system requirements (Graham 1966, 1972). Fan manufacturers present performance data in either graphics (curves) (Figure 13), tabular form (multirating tables), or selection software. Multirating tables usually provide only performance data within the recommended operating range. The optimum selection range or peak efficiency point is identified in various ways by different manufacturers.

One of the most important selection criteria for fans is energy use. In recent years, fan energy consumption has been addressed by several energy codes and regulations. For example, a building code or regulation may require fans in most applications to meet a minimum **fan energy index (FEI)**. The FEI is a metric used to characterize fan energy usage for fans inclusive of motors and drives. It is defined in AMCA *Standards* 208 and 214 and is being included in ISO *Standard* 12759-6. The FEI is the ratio of the electrical input power of a reference fan to the electrical input power of the actual fan for which the FEI is calculated, both at the same duty point (which is characterized by the value of airflow and fan pressure). The FEI can be calculated for each point on a fan curve. The FEI may be reported with the manufacturer's performance data or electronic selection tools. If not, consult the fan manufacturer.



Curve shows performance of a fixed fan size running at a fixed speed.

Fig. 13 Fan Performance Curve

Other codes and regulation also apply to the extended fan system. For example, the European EU *Directive* 327/2011: *Ecodesign—Fans* requires the extended fan system to meet a minimum efficiency metric that is similar to **fan motor efficiency grade (FMEG).** The FMEG is a wire-to-air efficiency metric and is defined in ISO *Standard* 12759:2010 (soon to be ISO *Standard* 12759-4, under development). Determination of FMEG is based on overall fan system peak efficiency, electrical input power, efficiency category, and fan type.

In addition to codes and regulations as related to the extended fan system, some apply only to the stand-alone fan (without drive components) such as the **fan efficiency grade (FEG)**. The FEG is a metric used to characterize fan energy efficiency and is defined in AMCA *Standard* 205-19 and ISO *Standard* 12759:2010 (soon to be ISO *Standard* 12759-3, under development). Fans that comply with a minimum FEG requirement must be selected so that the difference between peak total efficiency and total efficiency at the selection point is within a prescribed value (e.g., 15%, as shown in Figure 13).

Fans that do not meet the minimum requirements of a code or regulation cannot be considered for selection. The FEI, FMEG, and FEG are separate, distinct metrics for describing fan efficiency and energy usage. They can be used to establish compliance with applicable codes or regulations, but not as a means to make fan selections or to quantify actual fan performance in a given application.

Performance data as tabulated in typical manufacturers' fan performance tables or as shown by fan performance maps are based on arbitrary increments of flow rate and pressure. In the tables, adjacent data, either horizontally or vertically, represent different points of operation (i.e., different points of rating) on the fan performance curve. These points of rating depend solely on the fan's characteristics; they cannot be obtained from each other by the fan laws. However, points of operation listed in fan performance tables are usually close together, so intermediate points may be interpolated arithmetically with adequate accuracy for fan selection.

Selecting a fan for a particular air distribution system requires that the fan pressure capability matches with the system pressure loss at a design condition. For a fan system *with* a ducted outlet, the fan total pressure should be used for fan selection. On the other hand, for a fan system *without* an outlet duct, the fan static pressure should be used instead. Since the system pressure loss is the sum of all individual total pressure losses imposed by the air distribution system elements on both the inlet and outlet sides of the fan, the total system must be evaluated and airflow requirements, system resistances, system air leakage, and system effect factors at the fan inlet and outlet must be known (see Chapter 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* and Chapter 19 of this volume). Fan speed and power requirements are then calculated, using multirating tables or single or multispeed performance curves or graphs.

Fan manufacturers provide catalogs or electronic tools for making fan selections. Fan performance data (e.g., airflow rate, pressure rise, input power) are typically presented over a recommended range of fan operating conditions. When the fan is selected within this recommended range, airflow over the aerodynamic surfaces, such as the inlet cone and impeller blades, smoothly follows the surfaces in a way that results in good aerodynamic efficiency. However, when the fan operates outside of this recommended range, airflow may be unable to follow these surfaces and it breaks away, or separates, resulting in a number of undesirable effects. This condition, generally known as **stall**, is characterized by extensive regions of separated flow, increased noise, and highly unsteady behavior in the key flow variables (airflow rate, static pressure rise, and input power). The latter effect is known as **surge**. Fans operating under these conditions are subject to mechanical damage because of the large unsteady forces involved.

Different fan types exhibit stall and surge to varying degrees. Care must be taken when selecting a fan to ensure that operation

does not extend beyond the recommended boundaries provided by the fan manufacturer. Fan manufacturers provide a recommended selection range for each fan to avoid stall and flow pulsations. For further information about stall, refer to Eurovent (2007).

The selected point of operation (Figure 14) must represent a desirable point on the fan curve, to attain maximum efficiency and resistance to stall and pulsation. In systems where more than one point of operation is encountered, look at the range of performance and evaluate how the selected fan reacts within this complete range. This analysis is particularly necessary for variable-air-volume (VAV) systems, where not only the fan undergoes a performance change, but the entire system deviates from the relationships defined in Equation (2). In these cases, it is necessary to look at actual losses in the system at performance extremes and throughout the part-load operating range (where the system operates most of the time).

Special attention is needed to select the proper motor and any related drive components (e.g., belts, variable-speed drives). The motor and other component ratings must be sufficient to allow operation at all anticipated points of operation. Fans with overloading power characteristics and fans operating at elevated temperatures present areas of concern. Variable-air-volume systems may require special consideration if operated before system balancing. Techniques for assessing the effects of fan system component characteristics (i.e., fan, belt, motor, variable-frequency drive) on efficiency, power, and energy use throughout the operating range of a VAV system are described in DOE (2022).

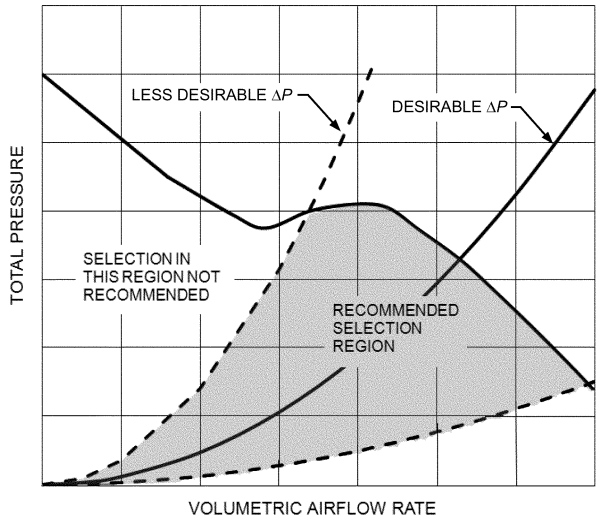


Fig. 14 Desirable Combination of P_{tf} and ΔP Curves

11. PARALLEL FAN OPERATION

When two identical fans with **stable** performance characteristics throughout the range of their individual performance curves operate in parallel, ideally their combined performance curve can be created by doubling the airflow of a single fan at any pressure level. Examples of such fans include backward-inclined centrifugal fans and axial-flow fans operated with a low pitch blade angle. Figure 15A illustrates a combined performance curve of two fans with stable operating characteristics.

When two fans with **unstable** performance characteristics (i.e., a pressure reduction to the left of the peak pressure point) operate in parallel, an unstable flow condition may occur if the fans operate too close to the peak pressure point of the combined performance curve. Figure 15B illustrates the combined performance curve of two fans operating in parallel.

Curve A-A of Figure 15B represents the pressure characteristic of a single fan. Curve C-C is the combined performance of two fans operating in parallel. All operating points to the right of point CD, the peak pressure point, are the sum of two times the airflow values for a single fan at the same pressure. The points are along the stable operating range of each fan. All systems with a resistance curve intersecting the combined performance curve to the right of point CD, such as resistance curve D-D, have stable flow characteristics.

Points to the left of point CD are the sum of all airflow values possible at the same pressure level of the fans. The points are along the unstable operating range of each fan. The double-loop shape (∞) seen in Figure 15B to the left of the peak pressure of two-fan operation is formed by summing the multiple airflows possible at a single pressure level. Systems with a resistance curve intersecting the performance curve in this region, to the left of point CD (e.g., resistance curve E-E), have unstable flow characteristics. Unstable flow is shown by the intersection of the system resistance curve at multiple points on the combined fan performance curve, points CE and CE'. The fans oscillate between these two points with random changes in airflow, noise, and vibration levels.

Avoid operating at unstable conditions. Always select fans to operate in their stable range, well to the right of the peak pressure point subject to the guidance in the section on Selection. If possible, plot the combined fan performance curve, including the double loop, and select the fan operating point along the stable portion of the performance curve to the right of the double loop.

When three or more identical fans are installed in parallel, the resulting airflow is the individual fan performance multiplied by the

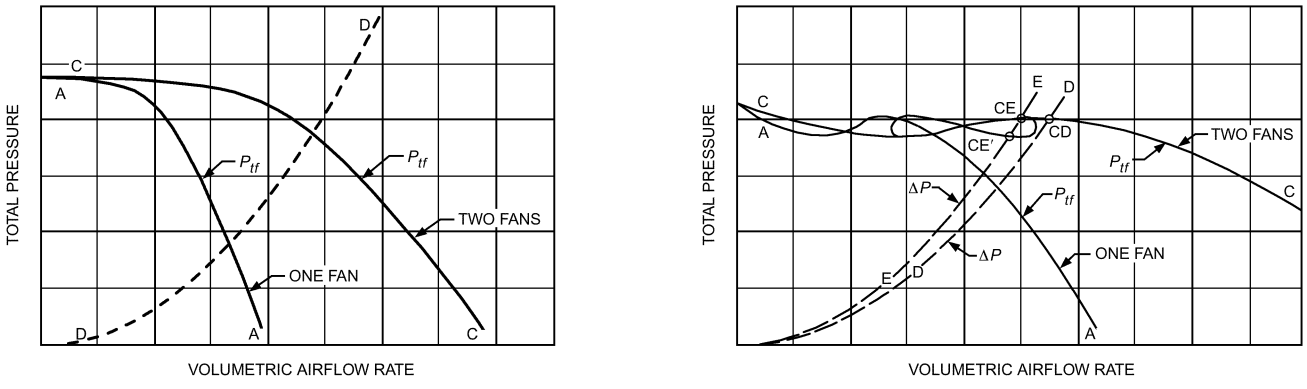


Fig. 15 Two (A) Stable and (B) Unstable Fans in Parallel Operation

number of fans in the system, for properly selected and installed fans. The designer must ensure that the operating point of each fan is well to the right of the peak to avoid oscillation of any one of the fans. Also, fan configuration (e.g., inlet and outlet duct orientation, distance between fans relative to impeller diameter) plays a major part in how well the system performs. Though parallel fan performance is easily estimated, actual performance may vary due to installation.

12. SERIES FAN OPERATION

Two identical fans operating in series theoretically double the pressure rise without changing airflow (Figure 16). Actual performance of the two fans operating in series will be less than the theoretical, because losses occur in the transition between the two fans and the second fan operates less efficiently. Lack of sufficient spacing and/or straightening of flow between the fans further reduces performance. At fan pressures below 7.5 kPa, air compressibility can be neglected. Above that limit, calculation of the operating point, fan material selection, and fan design should consider temperature rise caused by friction and compressible gases.

13. NOISE

Fan noise is a function of the fan design, volume flow rate Q, total fan pressure P_{tf}, and efficiency η_t. After the proper type of fan for a given application has been determined (keeping in mind the system effects), the best size selection of that fan is commonly based on efficiency, because the most efficient operating range for a specific line of fans is normally the quietest. Low outlet velocity does not necessarily ensure quiet operation, so selections made on this basis alone are not appropriate. Also, noise comparisons of different types of fans, or fans offered by different manufacturers, made on the basis of rotational or tip speed are not valid. The only valid basis for comparison are the actual sound power levels generated by the different types of fans when they are all producing the required volume airflow rate and total pressure. Obtain octave-band sound power level data from the fan manufacturer for the specific fan being considered.

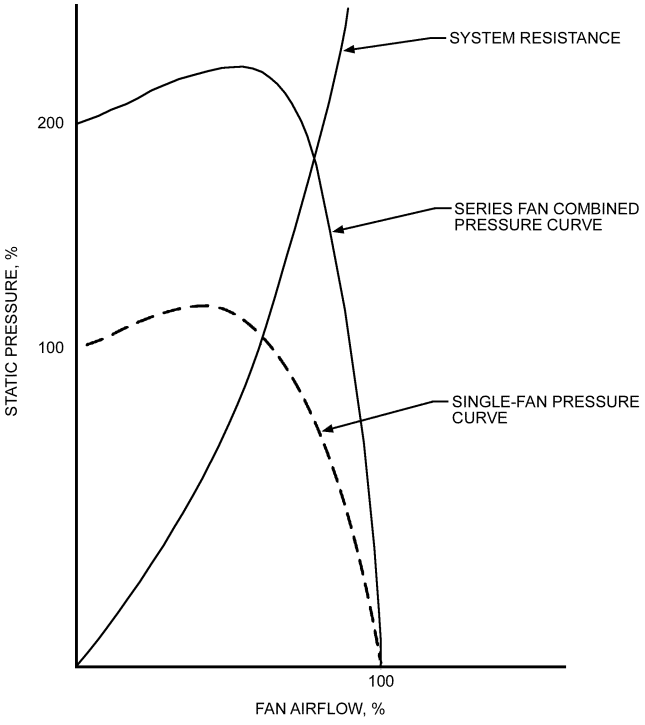


Fig. 16 Theoretical Characteristic Curve of Two Fans Operating in Series

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Sound power levels L_w can be determined using several different laboratory methods, such as a reverberant room comparing the sound generated by the fan to the sound generated by a reference source of known sound power; using an anechoic room; or using sound intensity measurements. The reverberant room measuring technique is described in AMCA *Standard* 300; the enveloping surface method, which uses an anechoic room, is described in ISO *Standard* 13347-3; and the sound intensity method is described in AMCA *Standard* 320. These standards do not fully evaluate the pure tones generated by some fans; these tones can be quite objectionable when they radiate into occupied spaces. On critical installations, make special allowance by providing extra sound attenuation in the octave band containing the tone.

Discussions of sound and sound control may be found in Chapter 8 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* and Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

14. VIBRATION

Fan vibration is the structural response of a fan to excitations caused by impeller imbalance, unsteady aerodynamic forces, and drive torque pulsations. The magnitude and extent of the structural response, or vibration level, is determined by the stiffness of the fan components, drive alignment, and bearing properties, among other factors.

Excessive vibration levels can lead to premature failure of the fan, produce high noise levels, and transmit undesirable forces into the support structure. Although fan vibration can never be entirely eliminated, acceptable levels can be achieved through proper fan design, manufacture, and application.

Acceptable vibration levels have been established from a long history of practical fan experience. AMCA *Standard* 204 defines recommended fan balance and vibration levels based on the fan application and fan drive power. The fan balance and vibration (BV) category, shown in Table 3, determines acceptable levels for fan balance quality and vibration levels.

Fan balance quality, or balance grade (e.g., G 6.3), is used to establish the maximum residual imbalance specification for a given fan speed and size. Balance grades for each of the BV categories are shown in Table 4.

Acceptable vibration levels, as measured in mm/s, are shown in Table 5. These levels are generally obtained using an accelerometer placed in the vicinity of the fan or motor. A newly commissioned fan would be expected to meet the start-up values given in the table. If alarm levels are reached during operation, appropriate steps should be taken to identify, contain, and correct the source of the vibration. The fan should be taken out of service if vibration levels exceed the shutdown values. Operation at these levels can lead to premature failure of the fan.

Acceptable vibration performance at the fan design conditions can be achieved by following these recommendations. However, with the widespread use of variable-speed control, fans may still produce excessive vibration levels at certain *critical* speeds that correspond to natural frequencies of the fan and/or fan support structure. These critical speeds should be avoided, or eliminated through proper design of the fan components.

The vibration level of a fan changes with fan operating condition and time. Therefore, it is important to monitor, or periodically check, the fan vibration level to ensure safe and reliable operation.

Vibration Isolation

During fan operation, vibration is transmitted to the support structure and building. This can lead to objectionable noise in occu-

Table 3 Fan Application Categories for Balance and Vibration

Application	Examples	Driver Power Limits, kW	Fan Balance and Vibration (BV) Application Category
Residential	Ceiling fans, attic fans, window AC	≤0.15	BV-1
		>0.15	BV-2
HVAC and agricultural	Building ventilation and air conditioning; commercial systems	≤3.7	BV-2
		>3.7	BV-3
Industrial processes, power generation, etc.	Baghouse, scrubber, mine, conveying, boilers, combustion air, pollution control, wind tunnels	≤298	BV-3
		>298	BV-4
Transportation and marine	Locomotives, trucks, automobiles	≤15	BV-3
		>15	BV-4
Transit/tunnel	Subway emergency ventilation, tunnel fans, garage ventilation	≤75	BV-3
		>75	BV-4
	Tunnel jet fans	All	BV-4
Petrochemical process	Hazardous gases, process fans	≤37	BV-3
		>37	BV-4
Computer chip manufacture	Cleanroom	All	BV-5

Source: Reprinted from AMCA *Standard* 204-05, Balance Quality and Vibration Levels for Fans, with written permission from Air Movement and Control Association International, Inc.

Table 4 BV Categories and Balance Quality Grades

Fan Application Category	Balance Quality Grade for Rigid Rotors/Impeller
BV-1*	G 16
BV-2	G 16
BV-3	G 6.3
BV-4	G 2.5
BV-5	G 1.0

**Note*: In category BV-1, there may be some extremely small fan rotors weighing less than 227 g. In such cases, residual unbalance may be difficult to determine accurately. The fabrication process must ensure reasonably equal weight distribution about the axis of rotation.

Source: Reprinted from AMCA *Standard* 204-05, Balance Quality and Vibration Levels for Fans, with written permission from Air Movement and Control Association International, Inc.

Table 5 Seismic Vibration Velocity Limits for In Situ Operation

Condition	Fan Application Category	Rigidly Mounted, mm/s	Flexibly Mounted, mm/s
Start-up	BV-1	14.0	15.2
	BV-2	7.6	12.7
	BV-3	6.4	8.8
	BV-4	4.1	6.4
	BV-5	2.5	4.1
Alarm	BV-1	15.2	19.1
	BV-2	12.7	19.1
	BV-3	6.4	16.5
	BV-4	10.2	10.2
	BV-5	5.7	7.6
Shutdown	BV-1	*	*
	BV-2	*	*
	BV-3	12.7	17.8
	BV-4	10.2	15.2
	BV-5	7.6	10.2

Source: Reprinted from AMCA *Standard* 204-05, Balance Quality and Vibration Levels for Fans, with written permission from Air Movement and Control Association International, Inc.

Values shown are peak velocity, mm/s, filter out.

*Shutdown levels for fans in fan application grades BV-1 and BV-2 must be established based on historical data.

pied spaces, or to undesirable vibration in other components of the HVAC system (e.g., the ductwork). Vibration isolation (e.g., coil springs, rubber-in-shear) can be used to attenuate the vibration reaching the building. More information on vibration and application of vibration isolation can be found in Chapter 8 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* and Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

15. ARRANGEMENT AND INSTALLATION

Direction of rotation is determined from the drive side of the fan. On single-inlet centrifugal f ans, the drive side is usually considered the side opposite the fan inlet. The AMCA *Standard* 99 series defines standard nomenclature for fan arrangements.

For a duct connected to a fan outlet or inlet, a flexible connection should be used to minimize vibration transmission. Provide access to the fan impeller for periodic removal of any accumulations tending to unbalance the rotor. When operating against high resistance or when low noise levels are required, it is preferable to locate the fan in a room away from occupied areas or acoustically treated to prevent sound transmission. The lighter-mass building construction common today makes it desirable to mount fans and driving motors on resilient bases designed to prevent vibration transmission through floors to the building structure. Conduits, pipes, and other rigid members should not be attached to fans. Noise that results from obstructions, abrupt turns, grilles, and other items not connected with the fan may be present. Treatments for such problems, as well as the design of sound and vibration absorbers, are discussed in Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

16. FAN CONTROL

Many fan applications require the air volume to vary in response to ventilation requirements. Control strategy selection is based on several considerations, such as frequency of airflow changes, effects on fan energy consumption, and first cost of control device(s).

Airflow control can be achieved by changing the system characteristic or the fan characteristic. Methods that change the system characteristic have low first cost, but generally consume more energy compared to methods that affect the fan characteristic.

System characteristic can be altered by installing dampers or orifice plates. This approach reduces airflow by increasing the system restriction. In general, the resulting input power is higher than that of a comparable fan correctly selected for the new airflow operating point. Dampers are usually the lowest-first-cost method of achieving airflow control and are sometimes used in cases where continuous control is needed, although other, more energy-efficient means are available.

Inlet vanes are a form of damper control that offer better energy efficiency. Inlet vanes are typically a series of triangular vanes located in the inlet of a fan. The vanes are controlled through a linkage mechanism, similar to a damper, with one important difference: the vanes are oriented such that incoming flow is turned to provide a preswirl into the fan impeller. In many cases, this can improve fan performance and offset the energy penalty of the vanes. Figure 17 illustrates the change in fan performance with inlet vane control. Curves A, B, C, D, and E are the pressure and power curves for various vane settings between wide open (A) and nearly closed (E).

Changing the fan characteristic (P_{tf} curve) for airflow control can reduce power consumption. One option is to vary the fan's rotational speed to produce the desired performance. If the change is infrequent, the speed of belt-driven fans may be adjusted by changing the drive pulley combination. More frequent changes using belt drive can be accomplished with adjustable sheaves that are manually, electrically, or hydraulically actuated. An alternative method for speed control, and the only option for direct-driven fans, is to

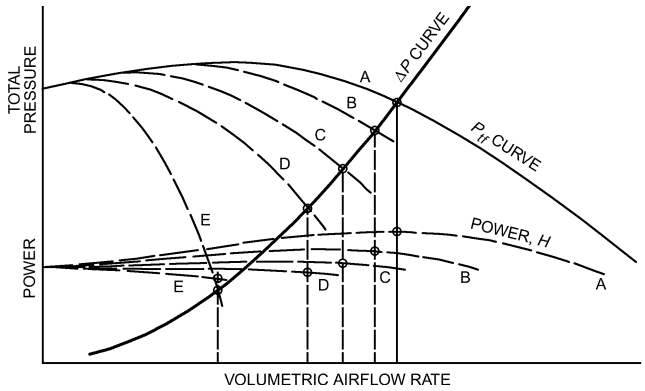

Fig. 17 Effect of Inlet Vane Control on Backward-Curved Centrifugal Fan Performance

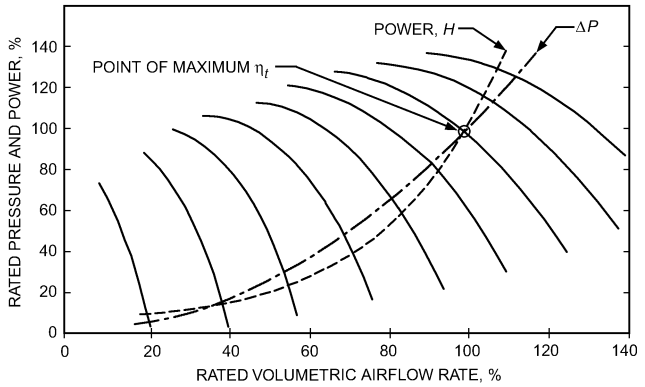

Fig. 18 Effect of Controlled Blade Pitch on Vaneaxial Fan Performance

vary the motor speed with a variable-speed control, such as a variable-frequency drive (VFD) or similar electronic device. Electronic motor speed control is often the best option from an energy consumption standpoint. When using variable-speed controls based on duct static pressure control, the fan characteristic can still be calculated with the fan laws.

An alternative to speed control is to change the fan geometry (especially blade setting angles) to optimize aerodynamic efficiency. This approach is more common in axial fans than with centrifugal fans.

Tubeaxial and vaneaxial fans are available with adjustable-pitch blades to allow balancing the airflow system, or to make infrequent adjustments. Vaneaxial fans can also be produced with controllable-pitch blades (i.e., pitch that can be varied while the fan is in operation) for frequent or continuous adjustment. Varying pitch angle retains high efficiencies over a wide range of conditions. The performance shown in Figure 18 is from a typical vaneaxial fan with variable-pitch blades. From the standpoint of noise, variable speed is somewhat better than variable blade pitch. However, both control methods give high operating efficiency and generate less noise than inlet vanes or dampers.

Table 6 summarizes control strategies and their relative energy consumption and first cost.

Further information on fan control as it relates to specific HVAC distribution systems may be found in Chapter 45 of this volume and in Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*. Additional information about estimating energy consumption during part-load operation is listed in the Fans, Pumps, and Distribution Systems section of Chapter 19 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. More detailed information about economic analyses is listed in Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Table 6 Summary of Control Strategies

Control Type	Control Method	Energy Consumption	First Cost
System characteristic	Orifice plates	High	Very low
	Dampers	High	Low
	Inlet vanes	Moderate	Medium
Fan characteristic	Variable sheaves	Moderate	High
	Motor speed (belt)	Moderate	High
	Motor speed (direct)	Low	High
	Variable pitch (axial)	Low	Very High

17. FAN INLET CONE INSTRUMENTED FOR AIRFLOW MEASUREMENT

A fan inlet cone has a flared inlet and a narrow throat for efficiently receiving and guiding airflow into a rotating fan impeller. An instrumented fan inlet cone uses pressure taps to measure static pressures at both the inlet and near the throat diameter. The difference between these static pressures, adjusted for the empirically determined characteristics of the inlet cone, is used as an indication of the fan airflow mainly for control purposes (Figure 19).

The technique is based on the Bernoulli and continuity equations, which allow calculation of flow through a converging nozzle based on measurement of the static pressure drop across the nozzle.

Airflow is estimated by the formula

$$Q = k\sqrt{\frac{\Delta P}{\rho}} \quad (3)$$

where

Q = airflow rate, m^3/s
k = inlet cone calibration factor, m^2
ΔP = differential pressure across inlet cone, Pa
ρ = actual air density, kg/m^3

If the fan inlet is entirely unobstructed, then single pressure taps at the cone's inlet and throat will suffice. Otherwise, two piezometer rings, each typically consisting of four conduit-connected pressure taps, should be used for pneumatic averaging. The inlet cone calibration factor should be established experimentally by test.

18. FAN TERMINOLOGY

Air. Term used as abbreviation for "air or other gases"; a mixture of atmospheric gases. Commonly used to denote any gaseous medium measured, moved, or controlled, and that may include solid or liquid particulate.

Airflow. A flow of air or an air current, specifically one that passes through a dimensionally defined plane.

Airflow rate. *See* **Volume airflow rate.**

Air system. An assembly of connected components such as ducts, coils, filters, conditioning devices, dampers, louvers, and fans for the purpose of moving air from one place to another.

Average air velocity. Volume airflow at a plane divided by the cross-sectional area of that plane.

Balance quality grade. Recommended limits for residual unbalance of a rotor, based on the intended application. The value represents the product of the unbalance multiplied by the angular velocity and divided by the mass of the rotor.

Balancing. The process of adding or removing mass in a plane or planes on a rotor to move the center of gravity towards the axis of rotation.

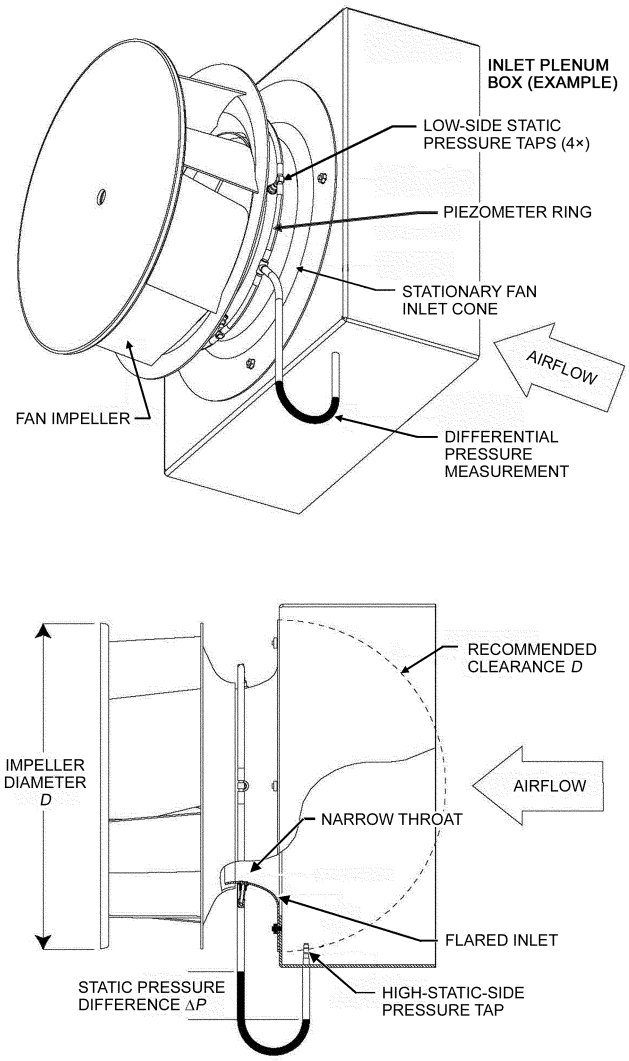

Fig. 19 Illustration of Instrumented Fan Inlet Cone
Source: Reprinted from AMCA *Publication* 600-16, Application Manual for Airflow Measurement Stations, with written permission from Air Movement and Control Association International, Inc.

Balancing speed. That rotational speed, expressed in revolutions per minute (rpm), at which a rotor is balanced.

Blade. The flow element of an impeller that, by its shape and motion, generates airflow inside a fan, transforming impeller rotational energy to kinetic energy of airflow.

Blade pass frequency (BPF). The frequency of a tone generated by the fan's blades, given by f(Hz) = (number of blades × fan revolutions per minute)/60.

Compressibility. The characteristic of air whereby its density is a function of pressure.

Compressibility coefficient. The ratio of mean airflow rate through the fan to the airflow rate at fan air density; the ratio of the fan total pressure that would be developed with an incompressible fluid to the fan total pressure that is developed with a compressible fluid (e.g., air, the test gas).

Critical speed. Rotational speed of a fan corresponding to the lowest natural frequency of the rotating fan impeller and shaft assembly when mounted on rigid supports without benefit of damping.

Dynamic similarity. A relationship between airflow systems requiring that the ratios of all corresponding forces in the two fans be equal. This includes ratios of forces due to elasticity, viscosity, gravity, surface tension, inertia, and pressure to show equivalence between two similar fans. The variables compared are fan Reynolds number, compressibility, gas specific heat ratio and tip speed Mach number at a point of operation.

Efficiency. Ratio of energy in the air provided by a dynamic application to the energy supplied to the system at a specific point of operation.

Fan. A device that uses a power-driven rotating impeller or impellers to move air or gas. The internal energy increase imparted by a fan to air or a gas is limited to 25 kJ/kg. This limit is approximately equivalent to a pressure of 30 kPa.

Fan air density. The density of air corresponding to the total pressure and total temperature at a fan inlet.

Fan air power. Product of the inlet flow rate, fan total pressure, and compressibility coefficient.

Fan airflow rate. The volumetric airflow rate at fan air density at the fan inlet or outlet.

Fan application category. Grouping used to describe fan applications, their appropriate balance quality grades, and recommended vibration levels.

Fan assembly. An assembly that consists of those items typically packaged together as "a complete fan," including, as applicable, rotor, bearings, belts, housing, motor, sheaves, and mounting base/structure.

Fan drives. Any device used to power the fan, including the motor, mechanical transmission (e.g., belt drive, coupling), and motor/control system (e.g., variable-frequency controller, electronic commutator).

Fan efficiency grade. The efficiency grade of a fan without consideration of the drives, as defined in AMCA *Standard* 205.

Fan electrical input power. The electrical power required to operate a fan, including any motor controllers, at a given duty point.

Fan energy index. The ratio of electric input power of a reference fan to the electric input power of the actual fan as calculated per AMCA *Standard* 214.

Fan housing. A stationary enclosure for an impeller. This enclosure has an inlet and an outlet and is designed to direct the flow of air through the impeller and towards the outlet.

Fan impeller. The assembled rotating component of a fan, designed to increase the energy level of the airstream.

Fan impeller power. The power delivered to a fan impeller, specifically the fan shaft power minus fan shaft losses (e.g. bearings, seals).

Fan inlet. The plane perpendicular to an airstream where the airflow first meets the inlet cone or the inlet box furnished by the fan manufacturer.

Fan inlet area. The gross inside area measured at the planes of inlet connections. For converging inlets without connection elements, it is considered to be the area where a plane perpendicular to the airstream first meets the inlet of the fan.

Fan input power. The mechanical power required to drive a fan.

Fan outlet. The plane perpendicular to the airstream at the outlet opening of the fan or the manufacturer-supplied evasé or diffuser.

Fan outlet area. The gross inside area measured at the plane of the outlet opening.

Fan outlet velocity. Average velocity of air emerging from an outlet measured in the plane of the outlet.

Fan peak efficiency. Maximum fan total or static efficiency with the fan speed and air density being fixed.

Fan performance characteristics. The total or static pressure and the volume airflow rate generated by a fan and its power consumption at any given point of operation.

Fan output power. The power delivered to the air. It is proportional to the product of the fan airflow rate, the fan total pressure and the compressibility coefficient. Sometimes called the fan's *air power*.

Fan Reynolds number (Re). A dimensionless parameter for judging dynamic similarity of flow in geometrically similar fans, relating inertia to viscous forces.

Fan rotor. A body capable of rotation, generally with journals that are supported by bearings.

Fan shaft. The spindle on which a fan impeller is mounted.

Fan shaft power. Mechanical power supplied to the fan shaft. *Note*: power loss in the fan shaft bearings is considered as a fan internal loss.

Fan sound power level. The ratio of sound power emitted by a fan to a reference value of 1.0×10^{-12} W. Sound power levels are normally presented in decibels.

Fan speed. Rotational speed of the impeller, typically measured in revolutions per minute (rpm).

Fan static efficiency. Fan total efficiency multiplied by the ratio of static pressure to total pressure at a given point of operation.

Fan static pressure. The difference between the fan total pressure and the fan velocity pressure. Therefore, it is the difference between static pressure at the fan outlet and total pressure at the fan inlet.

Fan static pressure rise. At a given point of fan operation, the increase in static pressure between fan inlet and fan outlet.

Fan total efficiency. At a given point of fan operation, a ratio equal to the fan power output divided by the power input to the fan.

Fan total pressure. At a given point of fan operation, the difference between total pressure at fan outlet and fan inlet.

Fan velocity pressure. The pressure corresponding to the average air velocity and density at the fan outlet.

Free air delivery. That point of operation where a fan operates against zero static gauge pressure.

Geometric similarity (geometric proportionality). A relationship requiring that the ratios of all corresponding dimensions for two fans be equal. This includes ratios of thickness, clearance, and roughness, as well as all the other linear dimensions of the airflow passages. All corresponding angles must be equal.

Guide vanes. Vanes located at the impeller or cabinet inlet or discharge to reduce swirl and to enhance static pressure regain from the airflow.

Housing. A stationary enclosure for an impeller, having an inlet and an outlet and designed to direct flow of air through the impeller and towards the outlet. The housing may also affect the energy transformation of the airstream.

Hub. The center portion of an impeller, which is connected to a shaft.

Impeller. *See* **Fan impeller.**

Impeller power. *See* **Fan impeller power.**

Kinematic similarity. A relationship between airflow systems requiring that the ratios of all corresponding velocities be equal for two fans to be considered similar. The directions and points of application of all corresponding vectors must be equal.

Kinematic viscosity. Absolute viscosity divided by mass density.

Mach number. Ratio of fluid velocity to the speed of sound in the same fluid.

Motor input power. Electrical power supplied to the terminals of an electric motor.

Motor output power. Power delivered from the output shaft of the motor.

Natural frequency. The frequency at which a system oscillates with a maximum amplitude in the absence of external forces.

Octave band. The interval between any two frequencies having a ratio of two.

Optimum Efficiency. *See* **Fan peak efficiency.**

Operating speed. Rotational speed, measured in revolutions per minute (rpm), at which a rotor operates.

Outlet area. *See* **Fan outlet area.**

Outlet velocity. The average velocity of air emerging from an outlet, measured in the plane of the outlet. Calculated by dividing the airflow rate by the outlet area.

Point of operation. The point on a performance curve corresponding to a particular airflow rate, pressure, power consumption, and efficiency.

Point of rating. A specified point of operation based on certain standard on a performance characteristic curve.

Propeller. An impeller that moves the air in an axial direction without creating radial flow.

Reynolds number (Re). A dimensionless number representing the ratio of internal forces to viscous forces at a particular point of a fluid in motion.

Shaft. A component used to support a rotating part, such as a fan impeller, and to transmit torque to the supported component.

Shut off. That point of operation on the fan performance curve where the airflow rate is zero.

Sound. An auditory sensation produced by the variation of pressure through an elastic medium.

Sound intensity level. The sound power level per unit area.

Sound power level. The value, expressed in decibels (dB), of ten times the logarithm (base 10) of the ratio of the sound power W to the reference sound power $W_{ref}(10^{-12})$ W.

Sound pressure level. The acoustic pressure at a point in space where a microphone or a listener's ear is situated. One decibel (dB) of sound pressure is defined as 20 times the logarithm (base 10) of the sound pressure fluctuation with reference to 20 mPa.

Standard air. Air at 20°C, 50% rh, and 101.325 kPa having approximately these properties:

- Density of 1.2 kg/m^3
- Specific heat ratio of 1.4
- Viscosity of 1.819×10^{-5} Pa·s
- Absolute pressure of 101.325 kPa

Static pressure. The pressure that exists by degree of compression only. If expressed as gauge pressure, it may be positive or negative.

Static regain. The amount of static pressure gained by conversion of velocity pressure to static pressure. This conversion takes place as air passes gradually from a small area to a larger area by means of a diffuser or an evasé.

System effect factor (SEF). A decrease in fan performance capability, observed as a pressure loss that results from the effect of fan inlet restrictions/obstructions, fan outlet restrictions or other conditions influencing the performance of the fan when it is installed in a system.

System pressure losses. The sum of the static pressure losses due to friction, shock, dissipation of velocity pressure at the system discharge, and static pressure differences between the entry and discharge openings of an air system.

Thrust. The reaction force due to the momentum change of the mass flow through the device.

Tip speed. The peripheral velocity of the fan impeller tips.

Total pressure. The air pressure that exists by virtue of the degree of compression and rate of motion of flowing air. It is equal to the algebraic sum of the velocity pressure and the static pressure at a point.

Trim balance. The process that makes minor unbalance corrections, which may become necessary as a result of the fan assembly or installation.

Unbalance. A condition of a rotor in which its rotation results in centrifugal forces being applied to the rotor's supporting bearings. Unbalance is usually measured by the product of the mass

of the rotor times the distance between its center of gravity and its center of rotation in a plane.

Vane (inlet). A flat or curved surface that can be rotated about an axis to direct airflow.

Velocity (dynamic) pressure. The pressure that exists by virtue of rate of motion only. Mathematically defined as [(density)(velocity)^2]/2.

Velocity profile. A distribution of velocities across a plane of the moving fluid.

Volume airflow rate. The volume of air that passes through a given area in a unit time.

19. SYMBOLS

A = fan outlet area, m^2
c_p = specific heat in Equation (1), J/(kg·K)
D = fan size or impeller diameter
d = area of inner cylinder
F_t = thrust of fan, N
H_o = power output of fan: based on fan volume flow rate and fan total pressure, W
H_i = power input to fan: measured by power delivered to fan shaft, W
k = inlet cone calibration factor in Equation (3), m^2
N = rotational speed, revolutions per minute
Q = volume airflow rate moved by fan at fan inlet conditions, m^3/s
P_{tf} = fan total pressure: fan total pressure at outlet minus fan total pressure at inlet, Pa
P_{vf} = fan velocity pressure: pressure corresponding to average velocity determined from volume airflow rate and fan outlet area, Pa
P_{sf} = fan static pressure: fan total pressure diminished by fan velocity pressure, Pa. Fan static pressure is also the difference between static pressure at outlet and total pressure at inlet.
P_{sx} = static pressure at given point, Pa
P_{vx} = velocity pressure at given point, Pa
P_{tx} = total pressure at given point, Pa
ΔP = pressure change, Pa
ΔT = temperature change, K
V = fan inlet or outlet velocity, m/s
η_s = static efficiency of fan: total efficiency of fan multiplied by ratio of fan static pressure to fan total pressure; $\eta_s = \eta_t(P_{sf}/P_{tf})$
η_t = total efficiency of fan; ratio of power output to power input; $\eta_t = H_o/H_i$
ρ = gas (air) density, kg/m^3

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CHAPTER 22

HUMIDIFIERS

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IN the selection and application of humidifiers, the designer considers (1) the environmental conditions of the occupancy or process and (2) the characteristics of the building enclosure. Because these may not always be compatible, compromise is sometimes necessary, particularly in the case of existing buildings.

1. ENVIRONMENTAL CONDITIONS

A particular occupancy or process may dictate a specific relative humidity, a required range of relative humidity, or certain limiting maximum or minimum values. The following classifications explain the effects of relative humidity and provide guidance on the requirements for most applications.

Health, Comfort, and Indoor Environmental Quality

There is a growing body of compelling evidence for a strong link between indoor relative humidity and occupant health, comfort, and indoor environmental quality.

Thermal Comfort, Eyes, and Skin. Derby et al. (2017) find (through a literature review [1985 to 2015]) that the impact of low humidity on comfort manifests as eye irritation, skin dryness, and static electricity.

Low humidity does not affect thermal comfort as long as temperature is suitable (Derby et al. 2017). Higher temperature is generally considered necessary to offset decreased relative humidity (see ASHRAE Standard 55).

Low relative humidity increases evaporation from the membranes of the nose and throat, drying the mucous membranes in the respiratory system; it also dries the skin and hair. Sunwoo et al. (2006) find higher eye evaporation rates or blink frequencies at lower humidities, but because tests were conducted on the time scale of minute to hours, long-term effects on comfort and visual acuity are unknown. In general, an ultra-low humidity environment (~2.5% rh) was found to be too dry and reduced worker comfort (Chou et al. 2005, 2007). In laboratory studies, low humidity increased transepidural water loss (TEWL) and skin discomfort (Wyon et al. 2006). However, in different studies within offices, humidification both yielded and did not yield a reduction in skin dryness. Very low humidity also increased the likelihood of static buildup. Nordström et al. (1994) document a significant decrease in electrostatic discharge complaints when relative humidity increases from 25 to 40%.

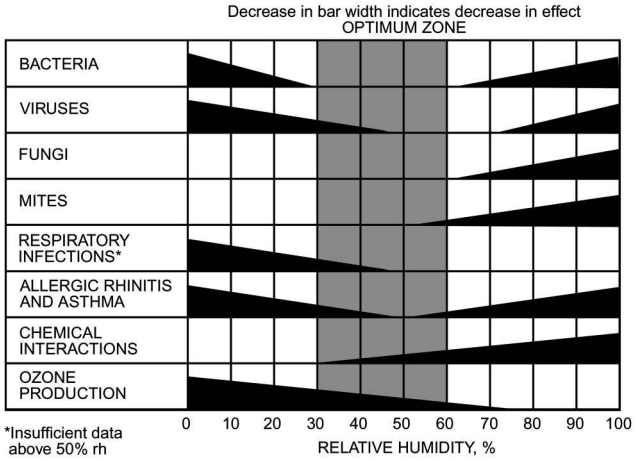


Fig. 1 Optimum Humidity Range for Human Comfort and Health

(Adapted from Sterling et al. 1985)

Indoor Environmental Quality (IEQ). Derby et al. (2017) determines that the effects of humidity on indoor environmental quality (IEQ) are modest. Results on the effects of relative humidity on volatile organic compound (VOC) emissions from building materials are inconclusive and depend on type of material and type of VOC. Emissions from materials may or may not vary with changes in temperature and humidity. In general, increases in temperature and humidity decrease the perceived quality or acceptability of the air. (Fang et al. 1998, 1999)

During one study, Fang et al. reported an increase of fatigue, headache, and difficulty thinking at lower levels of temperature and humidity. However, in another study, Norbäck et al. (1990) saw no correlation between room temperature and humidity and symptoms. Additionally, Fiedler et al. (2005) exposed women to brief (three-hour) mixtures of VOCs with and without ozone, and no significant subjective or objective health effects were reported as a result of the short VOC exposure.

Health. ASHRAE research project RP-1630 (Derby et al. 2017) findings indicate that low humidity (especially in cold air) triggers asthma (Bundgaard et al. 1982; Kaminsky et al. 1995), though the studies do not address specific lower humidity limits. Data included in house dust mite (HDM) literature by Arlian et al. support the conclusion that higher humidity levels encourage dust mite growth and subsequent HDM allergen production, and that controlling indoor relative humidity below approximately 50% can be an effective means of reducing house dust mite allergens. When considering the effects of low humidity on asthma, one must consider the interactions of allergies, ventilation, and viruses, as asthmatics are extremely susceptible to upper and lower respiratory tract infections.

The increased incidence of respiratory complaints during winter is often linked to low relative humidity. Epidemiological studies have found lower rates of respiratory illness reported among occupants of buildings with midrange relative humidity than among occupants of buildings with low humidity.

Extremes of humidity are the most detrimental to human comfort, productivity, and health. Figure 1 shows that the range between 30 and 60% rh (at normal room temperatures) provides the best conditions for human occupancy (adapted from Sterling et al. 1985). In this range, both the growth of bacteria and biological organisms and the speed at which chemical interactions occur are minimized. The trends of Figure 1 are, in general, correct, though the increasing widths of the bars designated "decrease in effect" are approximate at

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 5.11, Humidifying Equipment.

best. (Derby et al. 2017). Figure 1 has been adapted from its original published form. In the original work, an optimal range of 40 to 60% rh, was recommended. However, this has been expanded to include the 30 to 40% range, recognizing that higher humidity levels may not be feasible in cold climates.

Derby et al. (2017) make several observations across the comfort, IEQ, and health categories. Human subjects in this research were nearly always adults, and of these, a significant percentage of studies used university students, so it is unknown if the same conclusions apply to children, adolescents, and the elderly. Across the categories, ventilation was noted as a confounding factor, and this is a topic for future investigation. Time was noted as an important factor as well; most studies were conducted for a few hours, and long-term effects of low humidity are unknown.

Prevention and Treatment of Disease

The effect of relative humidity on occupant comfort has been considered a secondary concern compared to sensible temperatures. This oversight is partly because humans have no skin sensors for dryness. The role of relative humidity in occupant health, a more important consideration than comfort, has pushed management of indoor water vapor to the forefront. Relative humidity has a significant effect on the control of airborne infection.

One of the clearest examples of the importance of maintaining indoor rh between 40 and 60% for comes from a study of a hospital in the midwestern US. Over the course of one year, ten patient rooms were monitored for temperature, CO_2 levels, outdoor air fractions, lighting, visitor and clinician traffic, absolute and relative humidity, room pressurization, and RAC. These environmental parameters, measured every 5 to 30 minutes, were then statistically correlated with newly acquired healthcare-associated infections (HAIs) in approximately 300 patients residing in these rooms. Of all the room measurements, low relative humidity correlated the most significantly with increased HAIs (Taylor and Hugentobler 2016). In this study, as patient room relative humidity increased from 32 to 42%, the number of HAIs fell dramatically.

Reimann et al. (2018) expand on the prior works by testing the hypothesis that raising the absolute humidity above seasonal values would have an impact on influenza virus survival and transmission. The researchers added humidifiers to several classrooms within a Minneapolis school and controlled the room humidity in the range of 40 to 60% (as recommended by Sterling et al. 1985). These rooms were compared with control classrooms where no humidity control was present and the air became considerably drier during the cold winter months. Air and object samples were tested to determine the presence of influenza and its ability to infect cells. Additionally, occupant surveys determined the number of influenza-like infections within the classroom. Results of this study showed a significant reduction in the number of influenza A virus samples in rooms with humidification. Furthermore, influenza-like infections occurred 2.3 times more regularly in the control (not humidified) rooms. While the authors recommend further research, they do note that the humidification could serve as a solution for reducing influenza or other viral outbreaks.

Another study in a longterm care facility monitored patient infections and indoor conditions over a four-year period. (Taylor and Tasi 2018). The most significant parameter associated with increased patient infections, especially respiratory and gastrointestinal (GI) infections, was low indoor relative humidity. As shown in Figure 2, patient health was most optimal at indoor rh 40 to 60%.

Derby et al. (2017) draw several general conclusions regarding humidification effects on bacteria, viruses, and fungi. Influenza virus survival exhibits a canonical dip between 40 and 80% rh across many studies, and for nearly all cases, virus survival declined the longer the length of exposure. It has been hypothesized that changes of pH within the aerosol, induced by evaporation, may trigger conformational changes of the surface glycoproteins of enveloped viruses, leading to a decrease in viral infectivity (Yang and Marr 2012).

Kudo et al. 2019 examined the mechanisms through which mid-range 40 to 60% rh affects the body. This landmark study provides insights for the seasonality of the influenza virus epidemics, whereby inhalation of dry air compromises the host's ability to restrict influenza virus infection. The study shows that exposure of mice to low humidity conditions of 20% rh renders them more susceptible to influenza disease through impaired mucociliary clearance, decreased first line-of-defense against viral invasion of the respiratory tract, more lung damage from inflammation after viral disease, and defective tissue repair. Conversely, 50% rh was protective to the infected mice and associated with almost twice the survival rate, as shown in Figure 3.

While previous studies have clearly shown that environmental conditions such as dry air affect transmission of the flu virus, this is the first to show the mechanism through which humidification

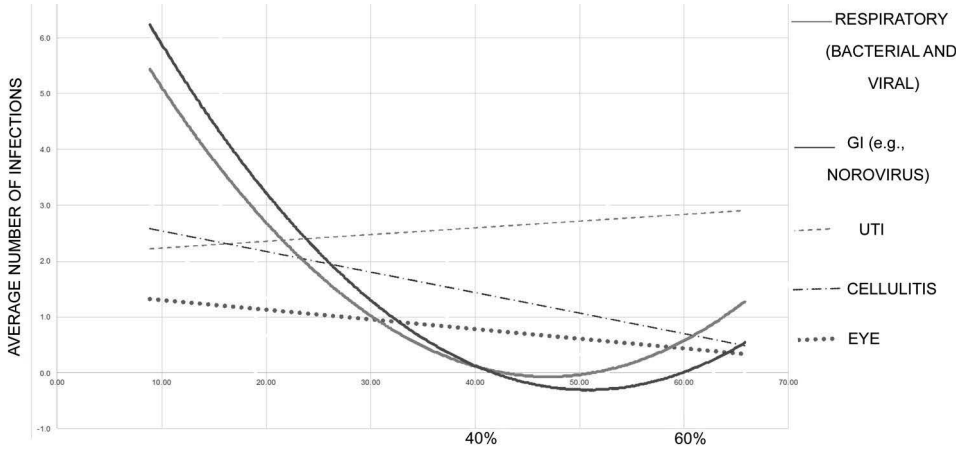


Fig. 2 Patient Infections at Indoor Relative Humidities

(Patient respiratory and gastrointestinal infections from viral and bacterial pathogens were lowest at indoor rh of 40 to 60%). (Taylor and Tasi 2018)

decreases illness and mortality in an animal model that applies to humans.

These recent works build on previous work showing that at 50% rh, the mortality rate of certain organisms is highest, and the influenza virus loses much of its virulence. The mortality rate of these organisms decreases both above and below this value. High humidity can support the growth of pathogenic or allergenic organisms. As shown in Figure 4, humidity levels around 50% can be lethal to the *Pneumococcus* bacterium (Brundrett 1990). Similar effects can be seen in other microorganisms that cause serious health issues. Consequently, relative humidity in habitable spaces should be maintained between 30 and 60%.

Relative humidity also has a major role in the effects of different bacteria. Figure 5 shows the mortality of mice exposed to influenza under varying degrees of relative humidity (Brundrett 1990).

During the COVID-19 pandemic much research was conducted on behavior of the SARS-COV-2 virus and opportunities to mitigate risks. Parhizkar et al. 2022 conducted a study with students at the University of Oregon who had been diagnosed with COVID-19. These students spent 3 days living in a specialized chamber where ventilation, filtration, and humidity was varied to determine the effect on infectious particles. This study found that higher humidity levels resulted in lower aerosol loadings in the air, and higher surface viral loadings due to increased particle deposition rates. This deposition effect was originally described in Noti et al (2013); infectious particles emitted into dry environments rapidly lost moisture mass to the air and became lighter enabling them to remain aloft and travel further. In higher humidity environments the moisture mass is retained, resulting in heavier particles, which settle out of the breathing zone more rapidly. Parhizkar et al. concluded that humidity was an important part of risk mitigation interventions within the building stating "*the findings indicate that building operation practices such as ventilation, filtration, and humidification substantially reduce the environmental aerosol viral load and therefore inhalation does, and should be prioritized to improve building health and safety.*"

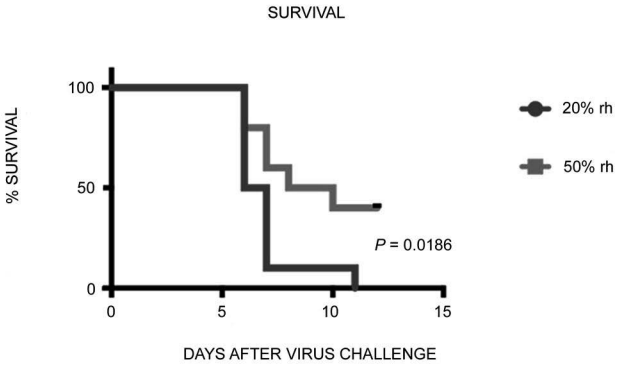


Fig. 3 Mice Survival Rates at 20 and 50% rh

(Mice maintained at 20 and 50% rh were infected with influenza A virus. Survival rates shown here.)
(Kudo et al. 2019)

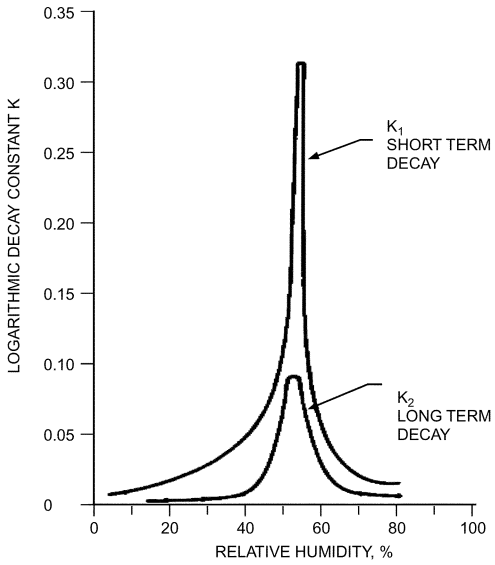


Fig. 4 Mortality of *Pneumococcus* Bacterium

Maximum mortality for airborne *Pneumococci* comes when relative humidity is held at 55% rh. (Adapted from Brundrett [1990], *Criteria for Moisture Control*. Copyright Elsevier © 1990.)

Electronic Equipment

Electronic data processing equipment requires controlled relative humidity. High relative humidity may cause condensation in the equipment, whereas low relative humidity may promote static electricity. Also, rapid changes in relative humidity should be avoided because of their effect on bar code readers, magnetic tapes, disks, and data processing equipment. Generally, computer systems have a recommended design and operating range of 35 to 55% rh. However, the manufacturer's recommendations should be adhered to for specific equipment operation.

Process Control and Materials Storage

The relative humidity required by a process is usually specific and related to one or more of several factors:

- Control of moisture content, regain or release
- Rate of chemical or biochemical reactions
- Rate of crystallization
- Product accuracy or uniformity

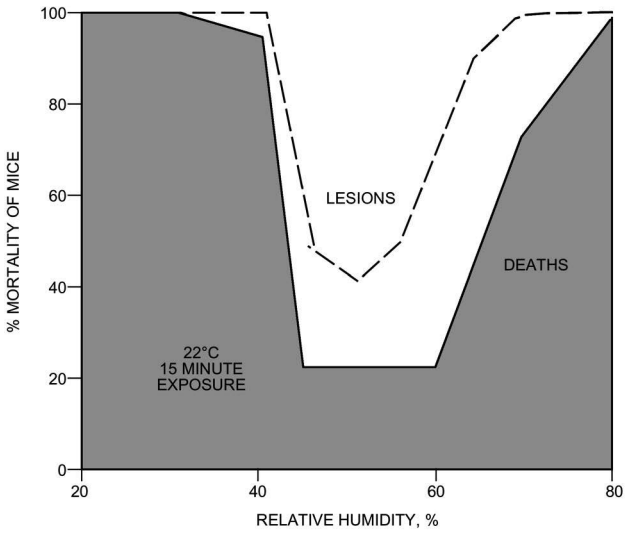


Fig. 5 Mortality in Mice Exposed to Aerosolized Influenza

Note that numbers of deaths and lung lesions were minimized when humidity was held between 40 and 60% rh.
(Adapted from Brundrett [1990], *Criteria for Moisture Control*. Copyright Elsevier © 1990.)

- Corrosion
- Static electricity

Typical conditions of temperature and relative humidity for storage of certain commodities and manufacturing and processing of others may be found in Chapter 15 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Low humidity in winter may cause drying and shrinking of furniture, wood floors, and interior trim. Winter humidification should be considered to maintain relative humidity closer to that experienced during manufacture or installation.

For storing hygroscopic materials, maintaining constant humidity is often as important as, or even more important than, the humidity level itself. This is particularly true of artwork and museum artifacts, which are sensitive to rapid changes in humidity and temperature.The design of the structure should always be considered. Temperature control is important because of the danger of condensation on products through a transient lowering of temperature.

Static Electricity

Electrostatic charges are generated when materials of high electrical resistance move against each other. The accumulation of such charges may have a variety of results: (1) unpleasant sparks caused by friction between two materials (e.g., stocking feet and carpet fibers); (2) difficulty in handling sheets of paper, fibers, and fabric; (3) objectionable dust clinging to oppositely charged objects (e.g., negatively charged metal nails or screws securing gypsum board to wooden studding in the exterior walls of a building that attract positively charged dust particles); (4) destruction of data stored on magnetic disks and tapes that require specifically controlled environments; and (5) hazardous situations if explosive gases are present, as in hospitals, research laboratories, or industrial clean rooms.

Increasing the relative humidity of the environment reduces the accumulation of electrostatic charges, but the optimum level of humidity depends to some extent on the materials involved. Based on the study by Paasi et al. (2001), electrostatic discharge (ESD) for several materials is a concern below 30% rh. Figure 6 illustrates the voltage that can be accumulated in the human body at different humidity levels. Relative humidity of 45% reduces or eliminates electrostatic effects in many materials, but wool and some synthetic materials may require a higher relative humidity.

Hospital operating rooms, where explosive mixtures of anesthetics are used, constitute a special and critical case. A relative humidity of at least 50% is usually required, with special grounding arrangements and restrictions on the types of clothing worn by occupants. Conditions of 22°C and 55% rh are usually recommended for comfort and safety.

Sound Wave Transmission

Air absorption of sound waves, which results in the loss of sound strength, is worst at 15 to 20% rh, and the loss increases as the frequency rises (Harris 1963). There is a marked reduction in sound absorption at 40% rh; above 50%, the effect of air absorption is negligible. Air absorption of sound does not significantly affect speech but may merit consideration in large halls or auditoriums where optimum acoustic conditions are required for musical performances.

Miscellaneous

Laboratories and test chambers, in which precise control of relative humidity over a wide range is desired, require special attention. Because of the interrelation between temperature and relative humidity, precise humidity control requires equally precise temperature control.

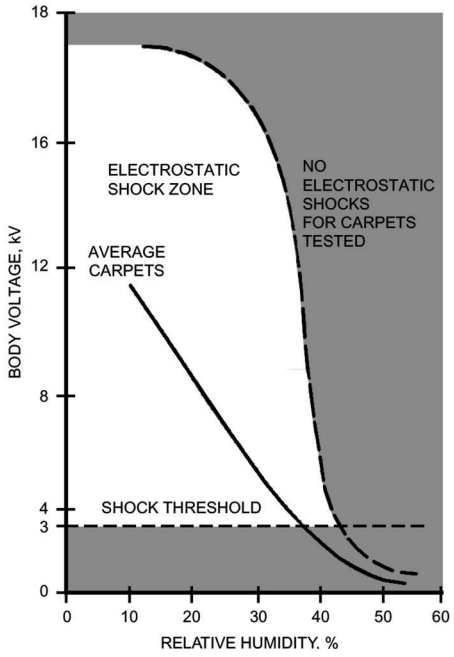


Fig. 6 Effect of Relative Humidity on Static Electricity from Carpets

Below 40% rh, perceptible shocks are more likely. (Adapted from Brundrett [1990], *Criteria for Moisture Control*. Copyright Elsevier © 1990.)

2. ENCLOSURE CHARACTERISTICS

Vapor Retarders

The maximum relative humidity level to which a building may be humidified in winter depends on the ability of its walls, roof, and other elements to prevent or tolerate condensation. Condensed moisture or frost on surfaces exposed to the building interior (visible condensation) can deteriorate the surface finish, cause mold growth and subsequent indirect moisture damage and nuisance, and reduce visibility through windows. If the walls and roof have not been specifically designed and properly protected with vapor retarders on the warm side to prevent the entry of moist air or vapor from the indoors, concealed condensation within these constructions is likely to occur, even at fairly low interior humidity, and cause serious deterioration.

Visible Condensation

Condensation forms on an interior surface when its temperature is below the dew-point temperature of the air in contact with it. The maximum relative humidity that may be maintained without condensation is thus influenced by the thermal properties of the enclosure and the interior and exterior environment.

Average surface temperatures may be calculated by the methods outlined in Chapter 25 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for most insulated constructions. However, local cold spots result from high-conductivity paths such as through-the-wall framing, projected floor slabs, and metal window frames that have no thermal breaks. The vertical temperature gradient in the air space and surface convection along windows and sections with a high thermal conductivity result in lower air and surface temperatures at the sill or floor. Drapes and blinds closed over windows lower surface temperature further, while heating units under windows raise the temperature significantly.

In most buildings, windows present the lowest surface temperature and the best guide to permissible humidity levels for no

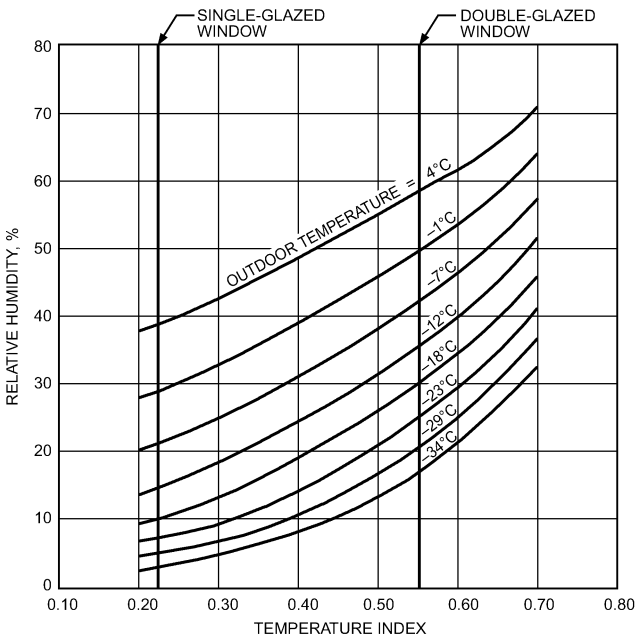


Fig. 7 Limiting Relative Humidity for No Window Condensation

condensation. While calculations based on overall thermal coefficients provide reasonably accurate temperature predictions at midheight, actual minimum surface temperatures are best determined by test. Wilson and Brown (1964) related the characteristics of windows with a **temperature index**, defined as $(t - t_o)/(t_i - t_o)$, where t is the indoor window surface temperature, t_i is the indoor air temperature, and t_o is the outdoor air temperature.

The results of limited tests on actual windows indicate that the temperature index at the bottom of a double, residential-type window with a full thermal break is between 0.55 and 0.57, with natural convection on the warm side. Sealed, double-glazed units exhibit an index from 0.33 to 0.48 at the junction of glass and sash, depending on sash design. The index is likely to rise to 0.53 or greater only 25 mm above the junction.

With continuous under-window heating, the minimum index for a double window with a full break may be as high as 0.60 to 0.70. Under similar conditions, the index of a window with a poor thermal break may be increased by a similar increment.

Figure 7shows the relationship between temperature index and the relative humidity and temperature conditions at which condensation occurs. The limiting relative humidities for various outdoor temperatures intersect vertical lines representing particular temperature indexes. A temperature index of 0.55 was selected to represent an average for double-glazed, residential windows; 0.22 represents an average for single-glazed windows. Table 1 shows the limiting relative humidities for both types of windows at various outdoor air temperatures.

Concealed Condensation

Vapor retarders are imperative in certain applications because the humidity level a building is able to maintain without serious concealed condensation may be much lower than that indicated by visible condensation. Migration of water vapor through the inner envelope by diffusion or air leakage brings the vapor into contact with surfaces at temperatures below its dew point. During building design, the desired interior humidity may be determined by the building enclosure's ability to handle internal moisture. This is particularly important when planning for building humidification in colder climates.

Table 1 Maximum Relative Humidity in a Space for No Condensation on Windows

Outdoor Temperature, °C	Limiting Relative Humidity, %	
	Single Glazing	Double Glazing
5	41	60
0	31	52
–5	23	45
–10	17	39
–15	12	33
–20	9	28
–25	6	24
–30	4	20
–35	3	17

Note: Natural convection, indoor air at 23.3°C.

3. ENERGY AND WATER CONSIDERATIONS

When calculating energy requirements for a humidification system, the effect of dry air on any material supplying it with moisture should be considered. The release of liquid in a hygroscopic material to a vapor state is an evaporative process that requires energy. The source of energy is heat contained in the air. Heat lost from the air to evaporate moisture equals the heat necessary to produce an equal amount of moisture vapor with an efficient humidifier. If proper humidity levels are not maintained, moisture migration from hygroscopic materials can have destructive effects.

The true energy required for a humidification system must be calculated from the actual humidity level in the building, not from the theoretical level.

A study of residential heating and cooling systems showed a correlation between infiltration and indoor relative humidity, indicating a significant energy saving from increasing the indoor relative humidity, which reduced infiltration of outdoor air by up to 50% during the heating season (Luck and Nelson 1977). This reduction is apparently due to sealing of window cracks by frost formation.

To assess accurately the total energy required to provide a desired level of humidity, all elements relating to the generation of humidity and the maintenance of the final air condition must be considered. This is particularly true when comparing different humidifiers. For example, the cost of boiler steam should include generation and distribution losses; costs for an evaporative humidifier include electrical energy for motors or compressors, water conditioning, and addition of reheat (when the evaporative cooling effect is not required).

Load Calculations

The humidification load depends primarily on the rate of natural infiltration of the space to be humidified or the amount of outdoor air introduced by mechanical means. Other sources of moisture gain or loss should also be considered. The **humidification load** H can be calculated by the following equations:

For ventilation systems having natural infiltration,

$$H = \rho VR(W_i - W_o) - S + L \quad (1)$$

For mechanical ventilation systems having a fixed quantity of outdoor air,

$$H = 3.6\rho Q_o(W_i - W_o) - S + L \quad (2)$$

For mechanical systems having a variable quantity of outdoor air,

$$H = 3.6\rho Q_t(W_i - W_o)\left(\frac{t_i - t_m}{t_i - t_o}\right) - S + L \quad (3)$$

where

H = humidification load, kg of water/h
V = volume of space to be humidified, m^3
R = infiltration rate, air changes per hour
Q_o = volumetric flow rate of outdoor air, L/s
Q_t = total volumetric flow rate of air (outdoor air plus return air), L/s
t_i = design indoor air temperature, °C
t_m = design mixed air temperature, °C
t_o = design outdoor air temperature, °C
W_i = humidity ratio at indoor design conditions, kg of water/kg of dry air
W_o = humidity ratio at outdoor design conditions, kg of water/kg of dry air
S = contribution of internal moisture sources, kg of water/h
L = other moisture losses, kg of water/h
ρ = density of air at sea level, 1.20 kg/m^3

Design Conditions

Interior design conditions are dictated by the occupancy or the process, as discussed in the preceding sections on Enclosure Characteristics and on Environmental Conditions. Outdoor relative humidity can be assumed to be 70 to 80% at temperatures below 0°C or 50% at temperatures above 0°C for winter conditions in most areas. Additional data on outdoor design data may be obtained from Chapter 14 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals.* Absolute humidity values can be obtained either from Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* or from an ASHRAE psychrometric chart.

For systems handling fixed outdoor air quantities, load calculations are based on outdoor design conditions. Equation (1) should be used for natural infiltration, and Equation (2) for mechanical ventilation.

For economizers that achieve a fixed mixed air temperature by varying outdoor air, special considerations are needed to determine the maximum humidification load. This load occurs at an outdoor air temperature other than the lowest design temperature because it is a function of the amount of outdoor air introduced and the existing moisture content of the air. Equation (3) should be solved for various outdoor air temperatures to determine the maximum humidification load. It is also important to analyze the energy use of the humidifier (especially for electric humidifiers) when calculating the economizer setting in order to ensure that the energy saved by "free cooling" is greater than the energy consumed by the humidifier.

In residential load calculations, the actual outdoor design conditions of the locale are usually taken as –6.7°C and 70% rh, while indoor conditions are taken as 21.1°C and 35% rh. These values yield an absolute humidity difference ($W_i - W_o$) of 0.0040 kg per kilogram of dry air for use in Equation (1). However, the relative humidity may need to be less than 35% to avoid condensation at low outdoor temperatures (see Table 1).

Ventilation Rate

Ventilation of the humidified space may be caused by natural infiltration alone or natural infiltration in combination with intentional mechanical ventilation. Natural infiltration varies according to the indoor-outdoor temperature difference, wind velocity, and tightness of construction, as discussed in Chapter 16 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. The rate of mechanical ventilation may be determined from building design specifications or estimated from fan performance data (see ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1).

In load calculations, water vapor removed from the air during cooling by air-conditioning or refrigeration equipment must be considered. This moisture may have to be replaced by humidification equipment to maintain the desired relative humidity in some industrial projects where the moisture generated by the process may be greater than that required for ventilation and heating.

Estimates of infiltration rate are made in calculating heating and cooling loads for buildings; these values also apply to humidification load calculations. For residences where such data are not available, it may be assumed that a tight house has an infiltration rate of 0.5 air changes per hour (ach); an average house, 1 ach; and a loose house, as many as 1.5 ach. A tight house is assumed to be well insulated and to have vapor retarders, tight storm doors, windows with weather stripping, and a dampered fireplace. An average house is insulated and has vapor retarders, loose storm doors and windows, and a dampered fireplace. A loose house is generally one constructed before 1930 with little or no insulation, no storm doors, no insulated windows, no weather stripping, no vapor retarders, and often a fireplace without an effective damper. For building construction, refer to local codes and building specifications.

Additional Moisture Losses

Hygroscopic materials, which have a lower moisture content than materials in the humidified space, absorb moisture and place an additional load on the humidification system. An estimate of this load depends on the absorption rate of the particular material selected. Table 2 in Chapter 15 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* lists the equilibrium moisture content of hygroscopic materials at various relative humidities.

In cases where a certain humidity must be maintained regardless of condensation on exterior windows and walls, the dehumidifying effect of these surfaces constitutes a load that may need to be considered, if only on a transient basis. The loss of water vapor by diffusion through enclosing walls to the outdoors or to areas at a lower vapor pressure may also be involved in some applications. The properties of materials and flow equations given in Chapter 26 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* can be applied in such cases. Normally, this diffusion constitutes a small load, unless openings exist between the humidified space and adjacent rooms at lower humidities.

Internal Moisture Gains

The introduction of a hygroscopic material can cause moisture gains to the space if the moisture content of the material is above that of the space. Similarly, moisture may diffuse through walls separating the space from areas of higher vapor pressure or move by convection through openings in these walls (Brown et al. 1963).

Moisture contributed by human occupancy depends on the number of occupants and their degree of physical activity. As a guide for residential applications, the average rate of moisture production for a family of four has been taken as 320 g/h. Unvented heating devices produce about 1 kg of vapor for each kilogram of fuel burned. These values may no longer apply because of changes in equipment as well as in living habits.

Industrial processes constitute additional moisture sources. Single-color offset printing presses, for example, give off 200 g of water per hour. Information on process contributions can best be obtained from the manufacturer of the specific equipment.

Supply Water for Humidifiers

There are three major categories of supply water: potable (untreated) water, softened potable water, and demineralized (deionized [DI] or reverse osmosis [RO]) water. Either the application or the humidifier may require a certain water type; consult the humidifier manufacturer's literature.

In areas with water having a high mineral content, precipitated solids may be a problem: they can clog nozzles, tubes, evaporative elements, and controls. In addition, solids allowed to enter the air-

stream via mist leave a fine layer of white dust over furniture, floors, and carpets.

Many humidifiers may bleed off or actively replace some or all of the water passing through the equipment to reduce the concentration of salts in the recirculating water. This allows for less frequent maintenance at the cost of increased water usage.

Dust, scaling, biological organisms, and corrosion are all potential problems associated with water in humidifiers. Stagnant water can provide a fertile breeding ground for algae and bacteria, which have been linked to odor and respiratory ailments. Bacterial slime reacts with sulfates in the water to produce hydrogen sulfide and its characteristic bad odor. Regular maintenance and periodic disinfecting with approved microbicides may be required (Puckorius et al. 1995). This has not been a problem with residential equipment; however, regular maintenance is good practice because biocides are generally used only with atomizing humidifiers.

Scaling

Industrial pan humidifiers, when supplied with water that is naturally low in hardness, require little maintenance, provided a surface skimmer bleedoff is used.

Water softening is an effective means of eliminating mineral precipitation in a pan-type humidifier. However, the concentration of sodium left in a pan as a result of water evaporation must be held below the point of precipitation by flushing and diluting the tank with new softened water. The frequency and duration of dilution depend on the water hardness and the rate of evaporation. Dilution is usually accomplished automatically by a timer-operated drain valve and a water makeup valve.

Demineralized or reverse osmosis (RO) water may also be used. The construction materials of the humidifier and the piping must withstand the corrosive effects of this water. Commercial demineralizers or RO equipment removes hardness and other total dissolved solids completely from the humidifier makeup water. They are more expensive than water softeners, but no humidifier purging is required. Sizing is based on the maximum required water flow to the humidifier and the amount of total dissolved solids in the makeup water.

Potential Bacterial Growth

Certain microorganisms are occasionally present in poorly maintained humidifiers. To deter the propagation and spread of these detrimental microorganisms, periodic cleaning of the humidifier and draining of the reservoir (particularly at the end of the humidification season) are required. Research by Unz et al. (1993) on several types of plenum-mounted (evaporative and steam) residential humidifiers showed no evidence of organism transmission originating from the humidifier. Ruud et al. (1993) also determined that humidifiers (evaporative and steam) did not add bacteria or particles to the heated airstream. Misting type systems, such as ultrasonic, fogging nozzles, and other systems that atomize water present a higher risk for distributing bacteria into the air if their reservoirs become contaminated. When using these types of products, care must be taken to heed the manufacturers cleaning and hygiene instructions to ensure safe operation of the system.

4. EQUIPMENT

Humidifiers can be broken into two basic categories, depending on when the energy is added for converting the water from a liquid to a gas in the humidification process. Each process results in different air temperatures during the humidification process, as seen in Figure 8. Table 2 shows the types of humidifiers in each category. See Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for more information on the humidification process.

Isothermal units use external energy to produce a steam vapor, and the humidification process results in a near-constant air temperature. All of the energy for producing the steam is added by the humidifier unit, before it enters the airstream. Isothermal units are typically called steam units by those in the industry, and fall into a couple of different groups of equipment as detailed in the paragraphs below. Because isothermal units produce only steam vapor, they are considered non-aerosol-generating humidifiers.

Adiabatic units allow direct contact between the water and airstream, and the humidification process results in a lower air temperature. All of the energy for the transformation, from liquid to gas, is provided by the airstream. Adiabatic units are typically called atomizers or evaporative systems, and fall into a couple of different groups of equipment: atomizing units are considered aerosol-generating, because they introduce water droplets directly into the airstream, whereas isothermal units are considered non-aerosol-generating, because the process only involves air absorbing the moisture as it passes over a pan or wetted device.

In Figure 8, during humidification, the isothermal system results in the air transformation of B to D. For the adiabatic system, the air transformation is shown as step C to D. For either process, the preheating steps of A to B or A to C are external to the humidification system, and are part of the air-handling system. Step B to C is equal to the energy that is required to convert the water from a liquid to a gas during the adiabatic process.

Humidifiers can generally be classified as either residential or industrial, although residential humidifiers can be used for small industrial applications, and small industrial units can be used in large homes. Equipment designed for use in central air systems also differs from that for space humidification, although some units are adaptable to both.

Air washers and direct evaporative coolers may be used as humidifiers; they are sometimes selected for additional functions such as air cooling or air cleaning, as discussed in Chapter 41.

The capacities of residential humidifiers are generally based on litres per day of operation; capacities of industrial and commercial humidifiers are based on kilograms per hour of operation. Published evaporation rates established by equipment manufacturers through test criteria may be inconsistent. Rates and test methods should be evaluated when selecting equipment. The Air-Conditioning, Heating and Refrigeration Institute (AHRI) developed *Standard* 610 for residential central system humidifiers, *Standard* 620 for self-con-

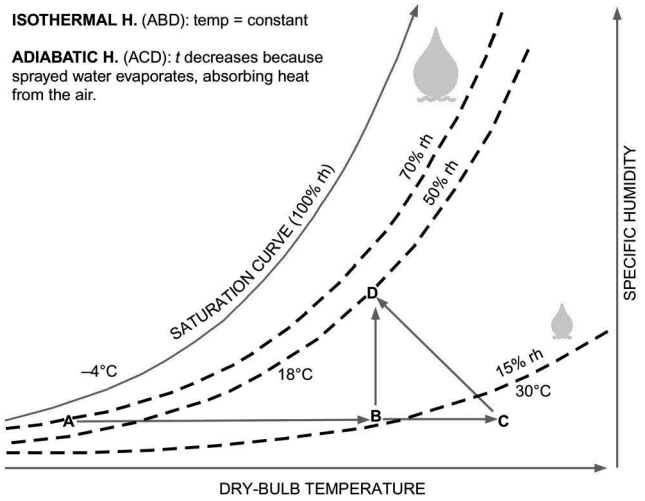


Fig. 8 Adiabatic Versus Isothermal Humidification Process

(Courtesy CAREL)

Table 2 Types of Humidifiers

Isothermal	Adiabatic
Steam heat exchanger	Ultrasonic atomizer
Hot-water heat exchanger	Centrifugal atomizer
Direct-injection steam	Pressurized-water atomizer
Electrode steam	Compressed air atomizer
Electric resistance steam	Wetted media
Gas-fired steam	Hybrid spray/media
Electric infrared steam	

tained residential units, and *Standard* 640 for commercial and industrial humidifiers. Association of Home Appliance Manufacturers (AHAM) *Standard* HU-1 addresses self-contained residential units.

Residential Humidifiers for Central Air Systems

Residential humidifiers designed for central air systems depend on airflow in the heating system for evaporation and distribution. General principles and description of equipment are as follows:

Pan Humidifiers. Capacity varies with temperature, humidity, and airflow. Vapor is introduced into the air by evaporation.

- **Basic pan.** A shallow pan is installed within the furnace plenum. Household water is supplied to the pan through a control device.
- **Electrically heated pan.** Similar to the basic unit, this type adds an electric heater to increase water temperature and evaporation rate.
- **Pan with wicking plates.** Similar to the basic unit, this type includes fitted water-absorbent plates. The increased area of the plates provides greater surface area for evaporation to take place (Figure 9A).

Wetted-Element Humidifiers. Capacity varies with air temperature, water temperature, humidity, and airflow volume. Vapor is introduced into the air by evaporation. Air circulates over or through an open-textured, wetted medium. The evaporating surface may be a fixed pad wetted by either sprays or water flowing by gravity, or a paddle-wheel, drum, or belt rotating through a water reservoir. The various types are differentiated by the way air flows through them:

- **Fan type.** A small fan or blower draws air from the furnace plenum, through the wetted pad, and back to the plenum. A fixed pad (Figure 9B) or a rotating drum-type pad (Figure 9C) may be used.
- **Bypass type.** These units do not have their own fan, but rather are mounted on the supply or return plenum of the furnace with an air connection to the opposite plenum (Figure 9D). The difference in static pressure created by the furnace blower circulates air through the unit.
- **In-duct type.** These units are designed for installation within the furnace plenum or ductwork with a drum element rotated by either the air movement in the duct or a small electric motor.

Atomizing Humidifiers. The capacity of an atomizing humidifier does not depend on the air conditions. However, it is important not to oversaturate the air and allow liquid water to form in the duct. The air's ability to absorb moisture depends on the temperature, flow rate, and moisture content of the air moving through the system. Small particles of water are formed and introduced into the airstream in one of the following ways:

- A **spinning disk or cone** throws a water stream centrifugally to the rim of the disk and onto deflector plates or a comb, where it is turned into a fine fog (Figure 9E).
- Spray nozzles rely on **water pressure** to produce a fine spray.
- Spray nozzles use **compressed air** to create a fine mist.
- **Ultrasonic vibrations** are used as the atomizing force, to produce a fine mist or fog.

Self-Contained Electrode Steam Humidifiers (Figure 9G). These units operate by passing an electric current directly into ordinary tap water, thereby creating heat energy to boil the water, and produce steam vapor. The humidifier usually contains a plastic bottle (see Figure 10E) that is supplied with water through a solenoid valve. Periodic and partial drains maintain a desirable solids concentration and the correct electrical flow. Units are available for steam distribution into the duct with a steam nozzle or wand, or into a room with a booster fan.

Residential Humidifiers for Nonducted Applications

Many portable or room humidifiers are used in residences heated by nonducted hydronic or electric systems, or where the occupant is prevented from making a permanent installation. These humidifiers may be equipped with humidity controllers.

Portable units evaporate water by any of the previously described means, such as heated pan, fixed or moving wetted element, or atomizing spinning disk. They may be tabletop-sized or a larger, furniture-style appliance (Figure 9F). A multispeed motor on the fan or blower may be used to adjust output. Portable humidifiers usually require periodic filling from a bucket or filling hose.

Some portable units are offered with an auxiliary package for semipermanent water supply. This package includes a manual shutoff valve, a float valve, copper or other tubing with fittings, and so forth. Lack of drainage provision for water overflow may result in water damage.

Some units may be recessed into the wall between studs, mounted on wall surfaces, or installed below floor level. These units are permanently installed in the structure and use forced-air circulation. They may have an electric element for reheat when desired. Other types for use with hydronic systems involve a simple pan or pan plate, either installed within a hot-water convector or using the steam from a steam radiator.

Industrial and Commercial Humidifiers for Central Air Systems

Humidifiers must be installed where the air can absorb the vapor; the temperature of the air being humidified must exceed the dew point of the space being humidified. When fresh or mixed air is humidified, the air may need to be preheated to allow absorption to take place.

Heated Pan Humidifiers. These units offer a broad range of capacities and may be heated by a heat exchanger supplied with either steam or hot water (Figure 10A). They may be installed directly under the duct, or they may be installed remotely and feed vapor through a hose. In either case, a distribution manifold should be used.

Steam heat exchangers are commonly used in heated-pan humidifiers, with steam pressures ranging from 35 to 105 kPa (gage). Hot-water heat exchangers are also used in pan humidifiers; a water temperature below 115°C is not practical.

All pan-type humidifiers should have water regulation and some form of drain or flush system. When raw water is used, periodic cleaning is required to remove the buildup of minerals. (Using softened or demineralized water can greatly extend time between cleanings.) Care should also be taken to ensure that all water is drained off when the system is not in use to avoid the possibility of bacterial growth in the stagnant water.

Direct Steam Injection Humidifiers. These units cover a wide range of designs and capacities. Steam is water vapor under pressure and at high temperature, so the process of humidification can be simplified by adding steam directly into the air. This method is an isothermal process because the temperature of the air remains almost

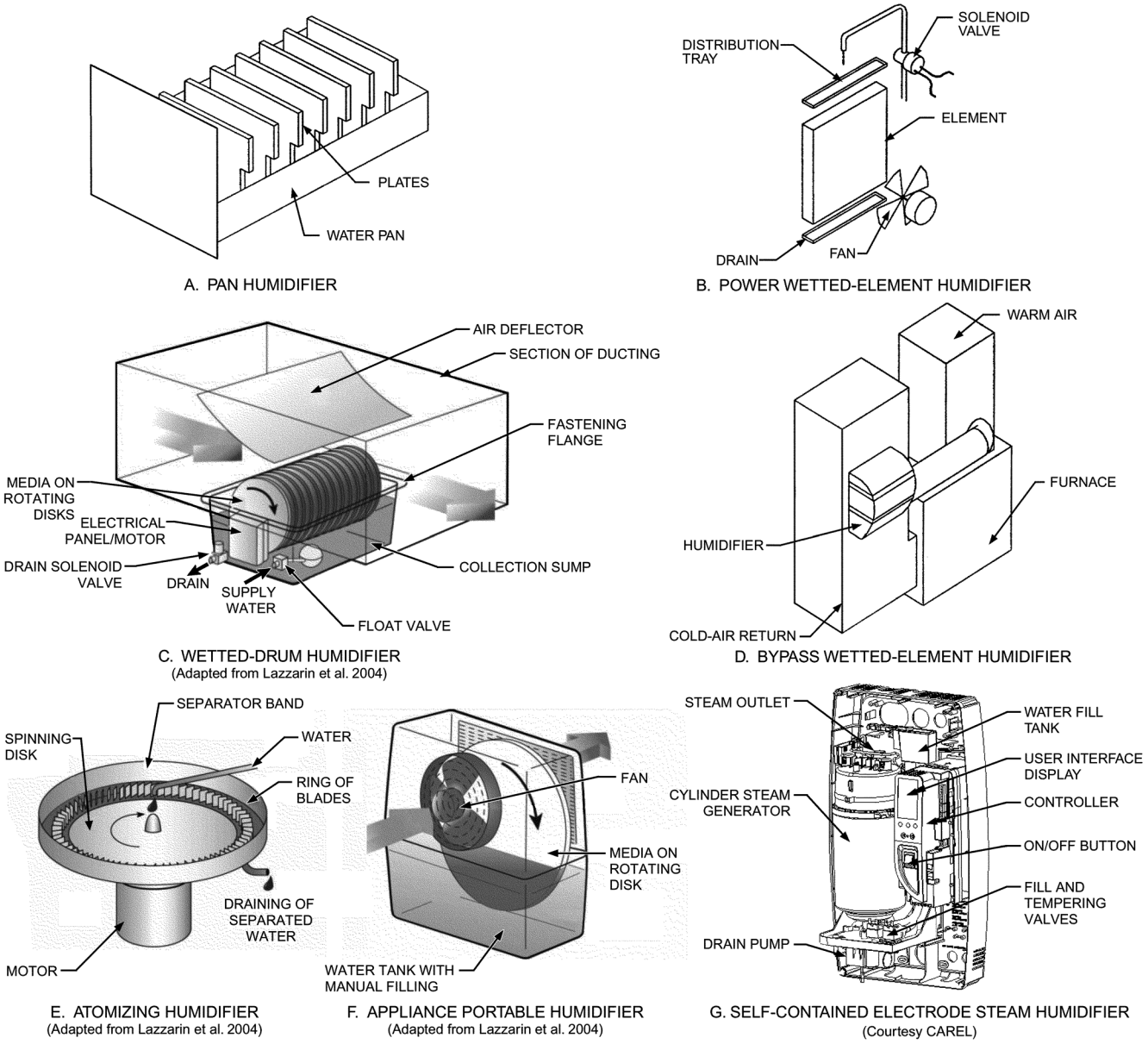


Fig. 9 Residential Humidifiers

constant as the moisture is added. For this type of humidification system, the steam source is usually a central steam boiler at low pressure. When steam is supplied from a source at a constant supply pressure, humidification responds quickly to system demand. A control valve may be modulating or two-position in response to a humidity sensor/controller. Steam can be introduced into the airstream through one of the following devices:

- Single or multiple **steam-jacketed manifolds** (Figure 10B), depending on the size of the duct or plenum. The steam jacket is designed to reevaporate any condensate droplets before they are discharged from the manifold.
- **Nonjacketed manifold** or **panel-type distribution systems** (Figure 10C), with or without injection nozzles for distributing steam across the face of the duct or plenum.

Units must be installed where the air can absorb the discharged vapor before it comes into contact with components in the airstream, such as coils, dampers, or turning vanes. Otherwise, condensation can occur in the duct. Absorption distance varies according to the design of the humidifier distribution device and the air conditions within the duct. For proper psychrometric calculations, refer to Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals.* Because these humidifiers inject steam from a central boiler source directly into the space or distribution duct, boiler treatment chemicals discharged into the air system may compromise indoor air quality. Check chemicals for safety, and carefully avoid contamination from the water or steam supplies.

Self-Contained Steam Humidifiers. These units convert ordinary city tap water to steam by electrical or gas energy using either electrodes, resistance heater elements, infrared lamps, or gas combustion. Steam is generated at atmospheric pressure and discharged

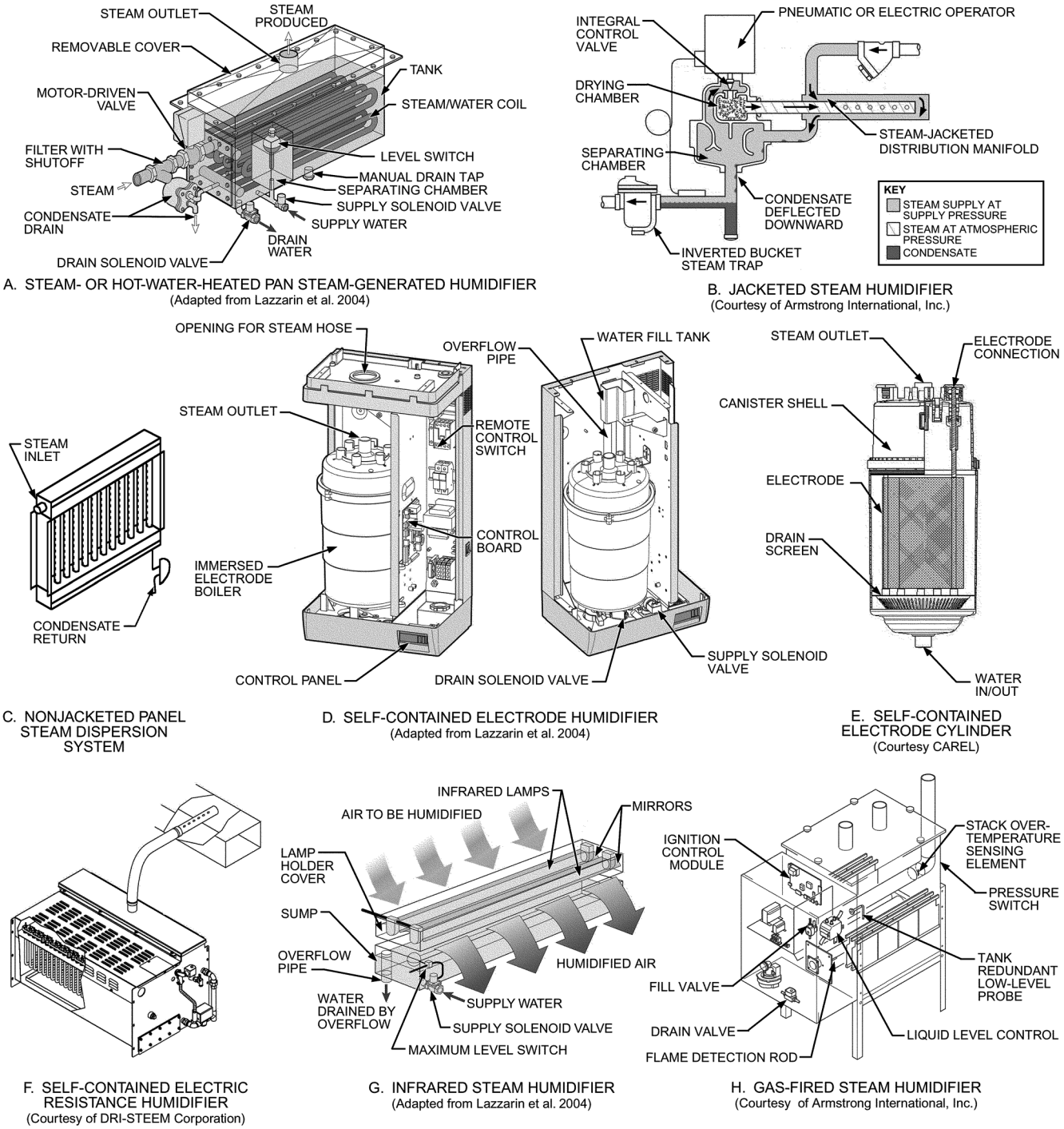


Fig. 10 Industrial Isothermal (Steam) Humidifiers

into the duct system through dispersion manifolds; if the humidifier is a freestanding unit, the steam is discharged directly into the air space or mixed in the airstream. Some units allow use of softened or demineralized water, which greatly extends the time between cleanings.

- **Electrode humidifiers** (Figure 10D) operate by passing an electric current directly into ordinary tap water, thereby creating heat energy to boil the water and produce steam vapor. The humidifier usually contains a plastic bottle (Figure 10E), either throwaway or cleanable, that is supplied with water through a solenoid valve. Periodic and partial drains maintain a desirable solids concentration and the correct electrical flow. Manufacturers offer humidifiers with several different features, so their data should be consulted.
- **Resistance humidifiers** (Figure 10F) use one or more electrical elements that heat water directly to produce steam. The water can be contained in a stainless or coated steel shell. The element and

shell should be accessible for cleaning out mineral deposits. High and low water levels should be controlled with either probes or float devices, and a blowdown drain system should be incorporated, particularly for off-operation periods.

- **Infrared humidifiers** (Figure 10G) use one or more quartz lamps to produce infrared energy that is reflected off mirrors and into a tank of water. The boiling water produces steam, which is then removed by air flowing over the surface of the tank. The water level and dilution drains are controlled by either solenoid valves, or an overflow system.
- **Gas-fired humidifiers** (Figure 10H) use one or more forced air combustion burners and heat exchangers to heat water to produce steam. The water is typically contained in a stainless steel tank, and the heat exchangers can be made from stainless steel or aluminum. The heat exchanger and tank should be accessible for cleaning out mineral deposits. High and low water levels should be controlled with either probes or float devices, and a blowdown drain system should be incorporated, particularly for off-operation periods.

Steam Distributors. Humidifiers that produce steam require a steam distributor to introduce the steam into an airstream or conditioned space. Correct selection and installation of both the steam distributors and the steam lines from the humidifier are essential for proper performance of the humidification system.

There are three common steam distributor types:

- **Individual-tube** distributors consist of one or more perforated tubes that are inserted into a section of ductwork. Steam from the humidifier escapes through holes in the tubes while condensate is collected and drained. Tubes are generally designed to span the width of the duct, and can be used individually or in groups to achieve a certain performance level.
- **Short absorption manifolds** (Figure 10C) are used in ducted or air handler applications and consist of multiple perforated distributor tubes connected to a central header. The multiple tubes spread the steam across as much of the airstream as possible, thus reducing the time and distance needed for the steam to be absorbed. However, the additional distributor tubes result in increased condensate loss and heat transfer to the airstream compared with a single-tube distributor. To minimize this effect, many short absorption manifolds are available with insulation.
- **Room fan** distributors (Figure 11) are used for direct room humidification without relying on a central HVAC system. Fan distributors can be built directly onto a humidifier or remotely mounted to distribute steam in a desired location. These distributors have the advantage of allowing the humidifier to operate independently of the ventilation system; however, they can result in a visible steam plume in the room. This plume may require some distance to fully absorb, so fans must be positioned with adequate clearance from occupants, walls, ceilings, and equipment. In addition, fan distributors also generate some noise from the motor and air movement in the fan. Both sound and absorption clearance are important considerations when placing these devices, particularly in quiet office environments.

Individual-Tube and Short Absorption Manifold Considerations. Both individual-tube and short absorption manifold distributors require tubes placed directly in an airstream. Increasing the number of tubes tends to shorten steam absorption distance, because the steam is more evenly distributed across the cross section of the airstream; however, it also increases the exposed area for heat transfer and thus also increases airstream heat gain and condensate losses in the distributor. It is best practice to minimize the number of tubes used while still maintaining absorption within the available distance. This approach reduces condensate losses and airstream heat gain while also reducing installation cost. To further reduce losses and improve efficiency, many manufacturers offer insulated distributors.

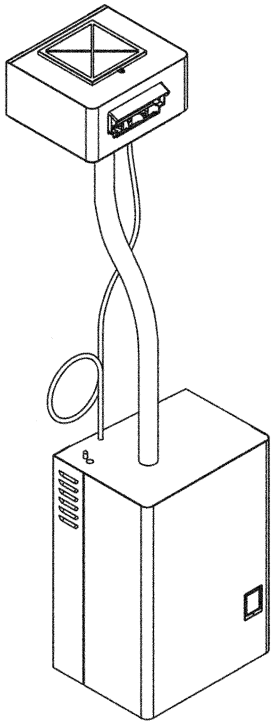


Fig. 11 Room Fan Distributor

Tubes and short absorption manifolds should both be located in a straight section of ductwork with laminar airflow. Avoid placing these distributors immediately after bends or in areas where turbulent airflow can be expected. Eddies and recirculation currents in these locations can cause the steam to be drawn into duct walls and condense.

Although not strictly required, it is good practice to include a drain pan in the distributor section to protect against possible leaks or condensation from the distributor.

Duct-mounted sensors and controls should be placed far enough away from the distributor for the moisture to mix adequately with the airstream. As a rule of thumb, high-limit controls and humidity sensors should be installed downstream at a minimum distance of five times the expected absorption distance.

Atmospheric Steam Lines. The steam lines that connect the humidifier to the steam distributors are another important part of the humidification system. Steam lines must be correctly sized, properly routed, made of correct material, have adequate drainage, and be insulated.

Sizing. Follow manufacturer guidelines when selecting an overall diameter. Lines that are too narrow create restriction that is difficult for the humidifier to overcome and can reduce system efficiencies. Lines that are too large have very low steam flow velocities and can cause high condensate losses. As a starting point, consider matching the diameter of the steam line to the outlet of the humidifier and maintaining this diameter through to the distributor.

Routing. Most stand-alone isothermal humidifiers generate atmospheric steam [i.e., steam at a very low pressure (1.5 to 4.5 kPa)]. As such, steam flow in these lines cannot travel long distances. Consider the following when routing steam lines:

- Keep atmospheric steam lines as short as possible

- Avoid long horizontal runs
- Maintain at a minimum slope of 15% for upward lines
- Maintain a minimum slope of 4% for downward lines
- Ensure lines are adequately supported to avoid unintentional low points
- Minimize the number of elbow and tee fittings

Materials. Material selection is an important aspect of steam line design. Common materials for atmospheric steam lines include copper tubing, stainless steel tubing, and hose. Compared to tubing, **piping** is costlier to install, has thicker walls, and has higher containment ratings that are not necessary for atmospheric steam. **Steam hose** is typically made of a flexible rubber or polymer material. Restrict steam hoses to short runs of 3 m or less, because the materials can soften and sag over time. Ensuring adequate support of steam hose is important to avoid low points where condensate can collect and block steam flow.

Plastic tubing and black iron piping are generally not recommended as materials for atmospheric steam lines. Certain types of plastic tubing can emit odors or become brittle from repeated heating cycles. Similarly, black iron pipe can emit odors from oils used during the manufacturing process and is prone to corrosion.

Draining. Condensate forms inside steam lines from heat losses and from cool lines on start-up. To minimize the risks of choking steam flow or discharging condensate from the distributor, this condensate should be removed through drains along the steam lines. It is best practice to place a drain and trap immediately before the distributor to collect and drain condensate before it can enter the distributor. Additionally, drains and traps should be placed every 4.5 m on steam line runs, and at any low points in the line. Low points often occur as the steam line is routed under beams, ductwork, or other piping.

A condensate drain should consist of a full-sized tee placed in the steam line, and a pressure trap. At a minimum, the trap must be sized to resist the maximum expected duct static pressure.

Condensate drained from steam lines can be recovered back to the humidifier, returned to a water treatment system, stored for irrigation and toilet usage, or directed to drain as directed by local codes. Steam line condensate is hot, often near 100°C, and should be cooled before draining. Commonly, a high-temperature condensate pump or a condensate cooling tank is used for this purpose.

Insulating. Heat transfer from steam lines can cause steam to condense back to liquid water. Losses in steam lines can reduce the overall system efficiency and reduce the amount of steam being distributed to the space. In the worst cases, significant line losses can prevent the humidifier from maintaining the desired humidity in the space. Therefore, atmospheric steam lines should be insulated with a suitable insulation for the chosen material.

Atomizing Humidifiers. Water treatment should be considered if mineral fallout from hard water is a problem. Optional filters may be required to remove mineral dust from humidified air (Figure12A). Depending on the application and the water condition, atomizing humidifiers may require a reverse osmosis (RO) or a deionized (DI) water treatment system to remove the minerals. It is also important to note that wetted parts should be able to resist the corrosive effects of DI and RO water. Atomizing humidifiers introduce fine droplets or a fog, directly into the airstream. A mist elimination system is suggested for all atomizing-type humidifiers.

There are four main categories of atomizing humidifiers:

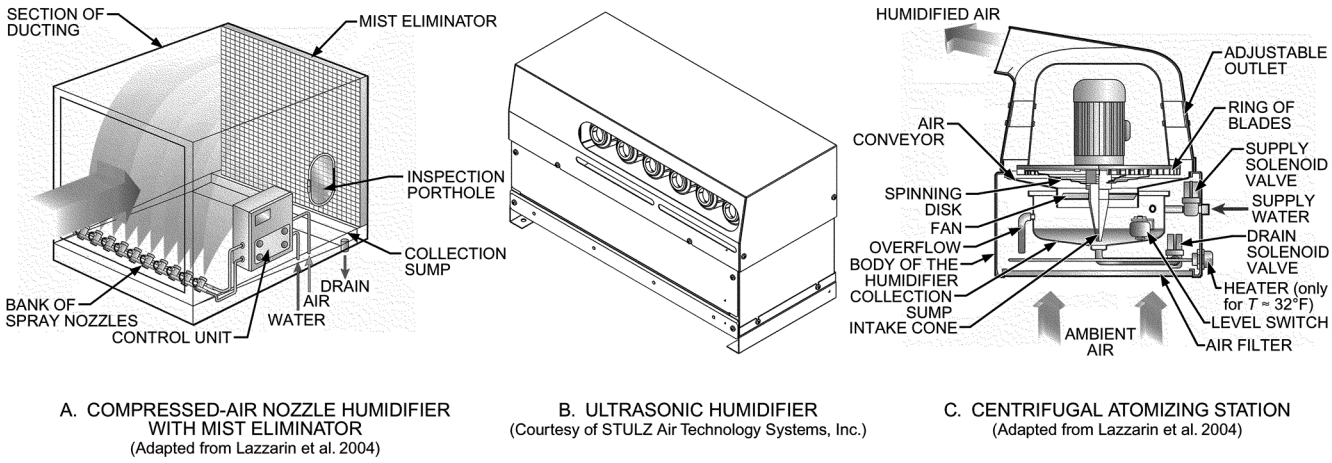
- **Ultrasonic humidifiers** (Figure 12B) use a piezoelectric transducer submerged in demineralized water. The transducer converts a high-frequency mechanical electric signal into a high-frequency oscillation. A momentary vacuum is created during the negative oscillation, causing the water to cavitate into vapor at low pressure. The positive oscillation produces a high-compression wave that drives the water particle from the surface to be quickly absorbed into the airstream. Because these types typically use demineralized water, no filter medium is required downstream. The ultrasonic humidifier is also manufactured as a freestanding unit.
- **Centrifugal humidifiers** (Figure 12C) use a high-speed disk that slings water to its rim, where it is thrown onto plates or a comb to produce a fine mist. The mist is introduced to the airstream, where it is evaporated.
- **Pressurized-water humidifiers** (Figure 12D) use a volumetric pump to generate water at pressures between 210 and 1265 kPa. This high-pressure water is then transferred to a duct, air handler, or ambient space by distribution piping, and discharged through special nozzles. The nozzles use swirl jet or impaction features (Figures 12E and 12F) to produce billions of very small droplets that spontaneously evaporate, humidifying and cooling the air.
  - A **duct** or **air handler pressurized-water system** typically consists of a pumping station, control sensor, distribution piping, a nozzle grid array with control solenoid valves, a mist eliminator section, and a limit sensor downstream of the mist eliminator.
  - An **ambient pressurized-water system** typically consists of a pumping station, control sensor, distribution piping, and a manifold circuit (with or without air blowers) containing spray nozzles.
- **Compressed-air nozzle humidifiers** (Figure 12A) use a system of air and water control unit, distribution piping and nozzles. The control sections manage the flow of air and water going to the nozzles. The nozzles can operate in two ways:
  - Compressed air and water are combined inside the nozzle and discharged onto a resonator to create a fine fog at the nozzle tip (Figure 12G).
  - Compressed air is passed through an annular orifice at the nozzle tip, and water is passed through a center orifice. The air creates a slight vortex at the tip, where the water breaks up into a fine fog on contact with the high-velocity compressed air.

Wetted-Media Humidifiers. **Rigid-media humidifiers** (Figure 12H) use a porous core and the process of evaporation. Water is circulated over the media while air is blown through the openings. These humidifiers are adiabatic, cooling the air as it is humidified. Rigid-media cores are often used for the dual purpose of winter humidification and summer cooling. They depend on airflow for evaporation: the rate of evaporation varies with air temperature, humidity, and velocity.

The rigid media should be located downstream of any heating or cooling coils. For close humidity control, the element can be broken down into several (usually two to four) banks having separate water supplies. Individual pumps or solenoids controlling water flow to each bank are activated as humidification is required.

Rigid-media humidifiers have inherent filtration and scrubbing properties because of the water-washing effect in the filter-like channels. Only pure water is evaporated; therefore, contaminants collected from the air and water must be flushed from the system. A continuous bleed or regular pan flushing is recommended to minimize accumulation of contaminants in the pan and on the media. A cycles-of-concentration method can be used to minimize scale build-up and water discharge.

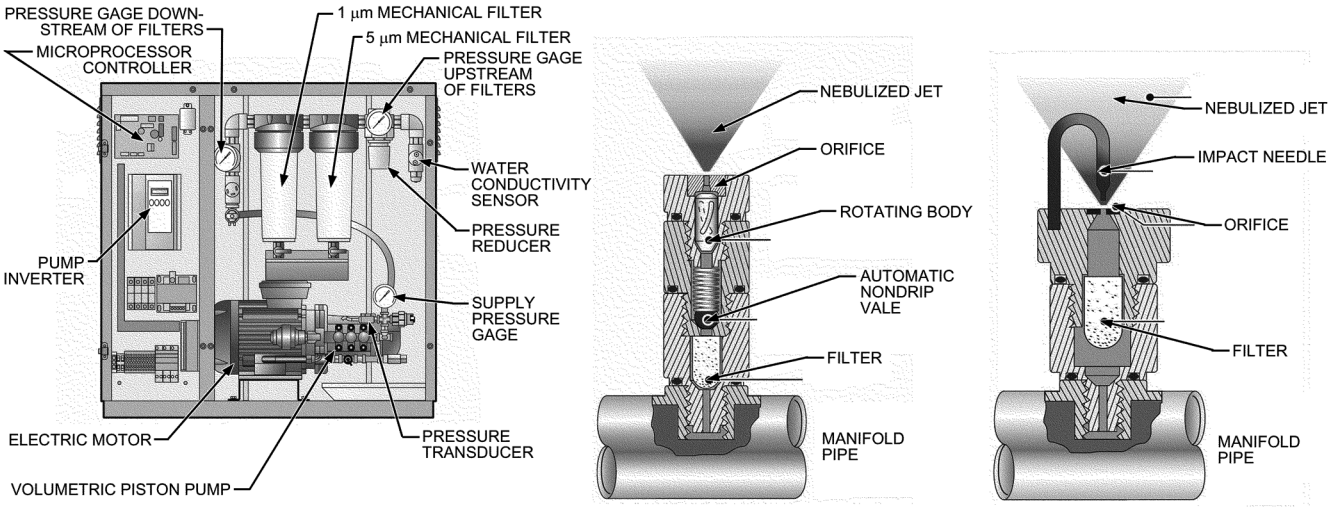
Hybrid Humidifiers. Hybrids (Figure 12I) combine a nozzle-type humidifier and a rigid-media humidifier. They are used in ducted or air handler applications. Nozzles, which typically operate at low pressure, are placed upstream of a rigid-media core and spray water into the airstream toward media. Droplets that do not evaporate are captured on the media and evaporated or drained off. The media functions as both a mist eliminator and an evaporator. Hybrid



A. COMPRESSED-AIR NOZZLE HUMIDIFIER WITH MIST ELIMINATOR
(Adapted from Lazzarin et al. 2004)

B. ULTRASONIC HUMIDIFIER
(Courtesy of STULZ Air Technology Systems, Inc.)

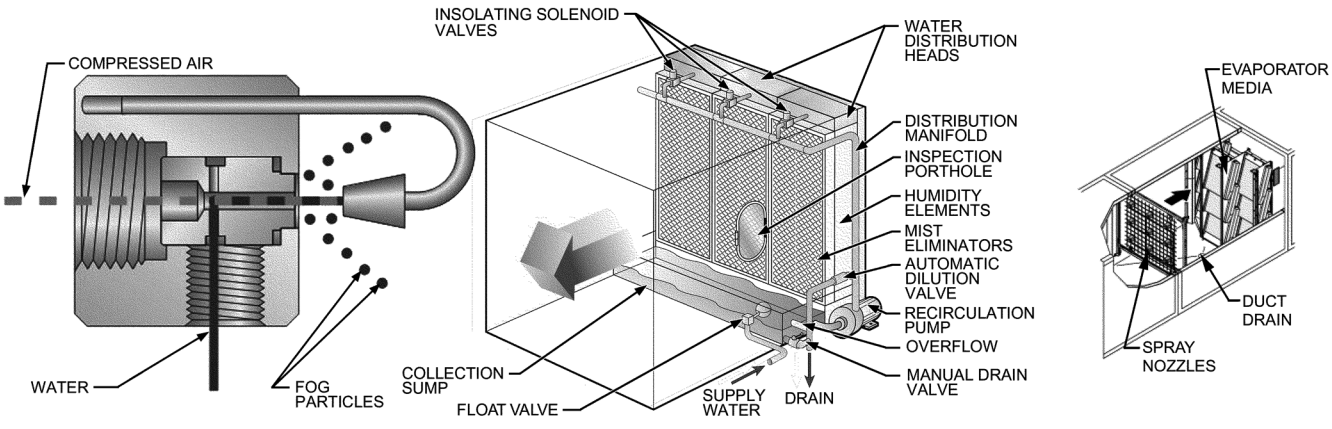
C. CENTRIFUGAL ATOMIZING STATION
(Adapted from Lazzarin et al. 2004)



D. HIGH-PRESSURE ATOMIZING STATION
(Adapted from Lazzarin et al. 2004)

E. HIGH-PRESSURE SWIRL JET NOZZLE
(Adapted from Lazzarin et al. 2004)

F. HIGH-PRESSURE IMPACT NOZZLE
(Adapted from Lazzarin et al. 2004)



G. COMPRESSED-AIR NOZZLE
(Courtesy of Armstrong International, Inc.)

H. RIGID-MEDIA HUMIDIFIER
(Adapted from Lazzarin et al. 2004)

I. HYBRID HUMIDIFIER
(Courtesy of Nortec Humidity Ltd.)

Fig. 12 Industrial Adiabatic (Atomizing and Evaporative) Humidifiers

humidifiers normally use either RO or DI water to prevent mineral precipitation from fouling the media.

Evaporative Cooling. Atomizing and wetted media humidifiers discharge water at ambient temperature. The water absorbs heat from the surrounding air to evaporate the fog, mist, or spray at a rate of 2500 kJ per kilogram of water. This evaporative cooling effect (see Chapter 41) should be considered in the design of the system and if reheat is required to achieve the final air temperature. The ability of the surrounding air to efficiently absorb the fog, mist, or spray depends on its temperature, velocity, and moisture content.

Selecting Humidifiers

Each type of humidifier has its own strengths and best applications (Table 3).

Table 3 Humidifier Advantages and Limitations

	Advantages	Limitations	Ancillary Equipment
Adiabatic			
Centrifugal	Simple Provides evaporative cooling to surrounding air	Difficult to apply to air-handling systems Limited capacity Possible plugging issues	N/A
Compressed air and water	Adjusts to changes in demand High turndown of output Customizable to air-handling systems Available in a wide range of capacities	Requires sufficient volume of compressed air Requires purified water Longer evaporation distances Requires sufficient preheat of air supply May generate noise	Air compressor Reverse-osmosis water treatment system Three-way drain valve Mist eliminator Controls and control panel
High-pressure atomizers	Same benefits as compressed air and water Benefits of atomization without cost of compressed air Provides evaporative cooling to surrounding air	Requires potable or better water source Requires sufficient preheat of air supply Longer evaporation distances	Reverse-osmosis water treatment system Mist eliminator Controls
Low-pressure atomizers	Benefits of atomization without cost of compressed air Potential energy benefit of evaporative cooling Lower energy consumption than high-pressure atomizers High evaporation efficiencies if used with a postevaporator Typically shorter evaporation distances than high-pressure atomizers Longer life on pumps because of lower operating pressures	Must stage discharge Requires purified water Requires sufficient preheat of air supply Requires service to prevent bacterial contamination	Optional reverse-osmosis water treatment system or water softener Mist eliminator or post evaporator Controls
Ultrasonic	Adjusts to changes in demand, modulates output High turndown of output Customizable to air-handling systems Provides evaporative cooling to surrounding air	Uses deionized (DI) water Requires sufficient preheat of air supply Longer evaporation distances Needs to have an accurate reservoir liquid level Limited output from each piezo crystal Requires frequent disinfection to reduce risk of microbial dispersion	Deionized water treatment system Mist eliminator Controls
Wetted-media evaporative	Available in a wide range of capacities Provides evaporative cooling to surrounding air Low energy consumption	Slow response to reduced demand Requires biocide Nonpurified water can lead to a build-up of impurities Water collection pan must be purged periodically	Controls Recirculation pumps
Direct-Injection Steam			
Steam cup	Simple design	Limited performance features Limits in control of steam output Limitations in allowable steam capacity Unrefined sound silencing Can disperse boiler chemicals into air	N/A
Steam jacketed manifold	Reliable performance Available in a wide range of capacities Adjusts to changes in demand Separates steam from condensate Sound silencing capability Low maintenance requirements Available with high turndown or valve rangeability Lifts condensate within stream pressure constraints Control valve can be adjusted electrically or pneumatically	Requires availability of a steam boiler Longer nonwetting distance than steam panel-type Can disperse boiler chemicals into air	Steam trap Wye-type strainer Temperature switch Controls
Steam panel	Reliable performance Available in a wide range of capacities Adjusts to changes in demand Separates steam from condensate Sound silencing capability Low maintenance requirements Available with high turndown or valve rangeability Short nonwetting distances Control valve can be adjusted electrically or pneumatically Performs without steam jacket or manifolds Can be insulated for energy savings	Requires availability of a steam boiler Can disperse boiler chemicals into air Difficulty lifting condensate from steam traps	Wye-type strainer Controls Condensate pump Manufacturer supplied and installed panel insulation

Table 3 Humidifier Advantages and Limitations (*Continued*)

	Advantages	Limitations	Ancillary Equipment
Heated Tank			
Electric (electrode type)	Compact size Provides a modulated output to a variable demand signal Available with cleanable or disposable tanks Available with self diagnostics Typically wall mounted	Water minerals precipitate out, remaining in tank Cannot use extremely low-conductivity water or purified water Performance can be adversely affected by long steam distribution pipe runs Softened water may not be usable	Fill cup extension kits for high-back-pressure applications Optional tank drain temperature-tempering device Controls Steam dispersion tube or steam dispersion panel for shorter nonwetting distance, or steam blower to disperse steam Steam hose with clamps for steam dispersion
Electric (resistive type)	Can use any type of fill water: tap, softened, RO/DI Some provide modulated output through SCR/SSR control Available with self diagnostics Can be wall, floor, or rooftop mounted	Water minerals precipitate out, remaining in tank Typically larger and heavier than electrode units	Optional tank drain temperature-tempering device Controls Steam dispersion tube or steam dispersion panel for shorter nonwetting distance, or steam blower to disperse steam Steam hose with clamps for steam dispersion Roof curb for outdoor mounting
Infrared steam humidifiers	Simple and compact design	Infrared bulbs are sensitive and fracture Limited output capacity Control accuracy Radiant energy is converted to heat rather than evaporating water	N/A
Gas-fired steam humidifiers	Can use any type of fill water: tap, softened, RO/DI Low energy costs Offers models with steam capacity greater than electric units Available with self diagnostics	Water minerals precipitate out, remaining in tank unless using RO/DI water Limitations in placement because of venting requirement	Steam dispersion tube or steam dispersion panel for shorter nonwetting distance, or steam blower to disperse steam Optional tank drain temperature-tempering device Controls Sealed combustion option for dedicated combustion air Roof curb for outdoor mounting
Steam-to-steam	Available with self diagnostics Additive-free steam High-capacity units available Can be floor or rooftop mounted	Water minerals precipitate out, remaining in tank Condensate pump required to lift condensate discharged from steam trap	Control panel, control valve, steam trap, and strainer Steam dispersion tube, steam dispersion panel for shorter nonwetting distance, or blower for dispersing steam Roof curb for outdoor mounting Optional tank drain water-tempering device
Hot water humidifiers	Available with self diagnostics Additive-free steam High-capacity units available	Water minerals precipitate out, remaining in tank Minimum temperature of liquid heat source is 115°C	Controls Optional tank drain temperature-tempering device Control panel, control valve, steam trap, and strainer Steam dispersion tube, steam dispersion panel for shorter nonwetting distance, or blower for dispersing steam

Source: Adapted from AHRI (2016).

5. CONTROLS

It is critical to consider how any humidification system will be properly controlled. Many aspects of the area to be humidified and how it interacts with other areas of the building must also be considered.

Water vapor concentrations equalize rapidly, moving from an area of high water vapor content to one of lower vapor content. If the space being humidified adjoins a space that does not have humidity control, the areas must be isolated or the combined area will be humidified. Similarly, if a humidified space is connected to a ventilation system that also serves nonhumidified spaces, the water vapor will equalize throughout the total area served by the ventilation system, which could require considerably increasing the humidification system size. Also, if a space is to be controlled to a lower humidity level than adjacent spaces or the environment, infiltration of moisture from the other spaces is likely as the water vapor concentration attempts to equalize.

Outdoor weather conditions can significantly affect the indoor relative humidity is a space. Cold outdoor air holds lower amounts of water vapor compared to warmer indoor air, and can lower the indoor humidity when introduced to the space. Similarly, when outdoor conditions are hot and humid, the higher water vapor content of the outdoor air will equalize with the lower water vapor in the indoor space.

Therefore, proper humidity controls must be installed to manage the humidification or dehumidification system serving a controlled space.

Several different types of controls are available to serve the requirements of the project. Controls commonly provide an on/off or a modulating signal, such as 0-10 VDC or 4-20 mA, as the humidity changes from the set point. Most humidistats can be used to activate either humidification or dehumidification systems.

Mechanical Controls

Mechanical sensors depend on a change in the length or size of the sensor as a function of relative humidity. Many humidity-sensitive materials are available, such as nylon, human hair, wood, and animal membranes that change length with humidity changes. The most commonly used sensors are synthetic polymers or human hair. They can be attached to a mechanical linkage to control the mechanical, electrical, or pneumatic switching element of a valve or motor. This design is suitable for most human comfort applications, but it may lack the necessary accuracy for industrial applications.

A humidity controller is normally designed to control at a set point selected by the user. Some controllers have a setback feature that lowers the relative humidity set point as outdoor temperature drops to reduce condensation within the structure.

Electronic Controls

Electrical sensors change electrical resistance as the humidity changes. They typically consist of two conductive materials separated by a humidity-sensitive, hygroscopic insulating material (polyvinyl acetate, polyvinyl alcohol, or a solution of certain salts). Small changes are detected as air passes over the sensing surface. Capacitive sensors use a dielectric material that changes its dielectric constant with relative humidity. The dielectric material is sandwiched between special conducting materials that allow a fast response to changes in relative humidity.

Electronic control is common in laboratory or process applications requiring precise humidity control. It is also used to vary fan speed on portable humidifiers to regulate humidity in the space more closely and to reduce noise and draft to a minimum.

Electronic controls are now widely used for residential applications because of low-cost, accurate, and stable sensors that can be used with inexpensive microprocessors. They may incorporate methods of determining outdoor temperature so that relative humidity can be automatically reset to some predetermined algorithm intended to maximize human comfort and minimize any condensation problems (Pasch et al. 1996).

Along with a main humidity controller, the system may require other sensing devices:

- **High-limit sensors** may be required to ensure that duct humidity levels remain below the saturation or dew-point level. Sometimes cooler air is required to offset sensible heat gains. In these cases, the air temperature may drop below the dew point. Operating the humidifier under these conditions causes condensation in the duct or fogging in the room. High-limit sensors may be combined with a temperature sensor in certain designs. The high-limit humidistat should be installed approximately 3 m from the humidifier section. This distance is necessary to allow for the moisture to be fully absorbed; high limits installed closer to the humidifier risk being damaged by moisture or cycling rapidly, causing short cycling of the entire humidification system. High-limit humidistats are commonly set to a maximum of 85 to 90% rh, and should be wired to close when the relative humidity falls below the set point and open when the relative humidity exceeds the set point.
- **Airflow sensors** should be used in place of a fan interlock. They sense airflow and disable the humidifier when insufficient airflow is present in the duct. An airflow switch is typically a sail or pressure switch that opens the control circuit of the humidifier when the airflow decreases or fails, and shuts the humidifier off. During system commissioning, confirm that this switch operates properly.
- **Steam sensors** are used to keep the control valve on direct-injection humidifiers closed when steam is not present at the humidifier. A pneumatic or electric temperature-sensing switch is fitted between the separator and the steam trap to sense the temperature of the condensate and steam. When the switch senses steam temperature, it allows the control valve to function normally.

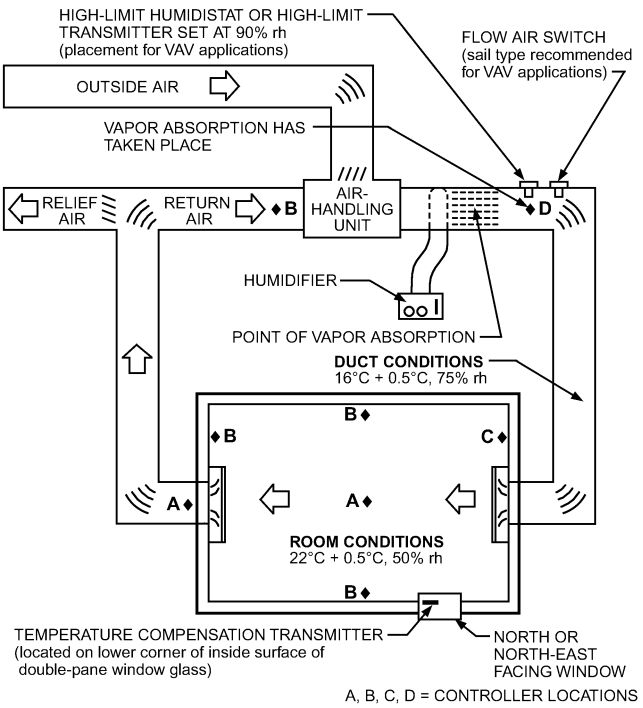


Fig. 13 Recommended Humidity Controller Location

Further information on humidity sensors can be found in Chapter 37 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Control Location

In centrally humidified structures, the humidity controller is most commonly mounted in a controlled space. Another method is to mount the controller in the return air duct of an air-handling system to sense average relative humidity. Figure 13 shows general recommended locations for the humidistat for a centrally air-conditioned room.

The manufacturer's instructions regarding the use of the controller on counterflow furnaces should be followed because reverse airflow when the fan is off can substantially shift the humidity control point in a home. The sensor should be located where it will not be affected by (1) air that exits the bypass duct of a bypass humidifier or (2) drafts or local heat or moisture sources.

Management Systems

In many applications, humidifiers can be integrated with the building management system (BMS). These types of systems can be set up with simple analog interaction with the humidifier, or by various communication protocols.

For analog-type systems, the management system can enable/disable the unit, send proportional signals for direct humidity control, or

redirect humidity sensor signals. These types of systems use various analog and digital outputs and inputs to command the humidifiers to operate, and at what level, as well as receive alarm states.

Communication protocols can be used as well to interact with and control humidification equipment. Common protocols include BACnet®, LonWorks®, Modbus®, TCP/IP, and SNMP. In some cases, these protocols can fully control the humidifier, replacing the need for any analog wiring, or can monitor the status and operation of the unit, or a combination of both. Some equipment providers can also supply a user interface system that offers online access to the status and operation modes of the units. See ASHRAE *Standard* 135 for more information.

6. APPLICATION CONSIDERATIONS

Humidity Control with Direct Space Humidification

Often, humidifiers are installed directly in the space they are humidifying, using humidity controllers (humidistats) for control, either installed directly within the space or mounted in the duct system of the ventilation unit serving the area. It is critical that space humidistats be located where they can sense the actual temperature and humidity of the controlled space. Normally, this requires that they are located at the working level of the facility on an interior wall or column. Humidistats should not be installed in the following areas:

- On exterior walls
- In drafts created by the HVAC system or interior machinery
- On surfaces affected or heated by sunlight, traffic, heat from machinery, lights, or other devices
- Near skids of materials stored in hot or cold warehouses
- Near rest rooms, washing facilities, or areas where moisture or heat is produced

In these areas, local changes in temperature or moisture cause the sensed relative humidity level to differ from the space as a whole.

It is good practice to install a high-limit humidistat to protect the space from possible excessive humidity in case the controlling humidistat fails or is damaged. Normally, this high-limit humidistat is an on/off type with a set point of 5 to 10% above the desired space conditions. It is then wired to open the control circuit of the humidifier and turn the humidifier off in case the control humidistat fails to properly shut the system off.

Humidity Control with Duct-Mounted Humidification

Humidifiers are commonly installed in ductwork or an air-handling unit (AHU) to control the temperature and humidity in the space or building as a whole. For these systems, best practice is to include the following controls:

- Space humidity controller
- Duct high-limit humidity controller
- Duct air proving switch for each humidifier

The space humidity controller can mount either directly within the conditioned space or in the return duct leaving the conditioned space. If using the return duct method, ensure that the humidistat senses conditions representative of the space as opposed to elevated temperatures or humidity levels resulting from machinery, stratification at the ceiling, or other process in the space.

When installing humidifiers in the AHU or supply duct, consider the psychrometrics of the airstream where the humidifiers are located. Warm air can absorb more water vapor than cold air, and the temperature and volume of air flowing through the ventilation system must be able to absorb the moisture being added to the airstream without becoming saturated. If the supply air is significantly cooler than the space design, the supply air may not be able to transport the required amount of moisture to satisfy the humidification load. For example, space design conditions of 24°C and 50% rh require 0.00944 kg of moisture per kilogram of air. Supply air at 13°C can only hold 0.00937 kg of moisture per kilogram of air and will be fully saturated under these conditions. The excess moisture that cannot be absorbed will likely become deposited in the duct or AHU, where it can cause bacterial growth, odors, or corrosion.

When using steam for humidification, the characteristics of the steam distributor should be considered. Adequate distance must be allotted for the steam to fully absorb to prevent unintended condensation on coils and other surfaces in the ventilation system. It is important to keep in mind that hot steam distributor tubes often contribute a small amount of heat to the airstream, which can increase the supply air temperature.

When using adiabatic humidification, consider the energy required to evaporate the water being discharge into the airstream. Evaporating a kilogram of water extracts 2500 kJ/kg from the airstream. As a result, the airstream leaving the adiabatic humidifier will be significantly cooler than the airstream entering the humidifier. Air preheating may be required to offset this cooling effect.

Humidity Control in Variable-Air-Volume Systems

Control in variable-air-volume (VAV) systems is much more demanding than in constant-volume systems. VAV systems, common in large, central-station applications, control space temperature by varying the volume rather than the temperature of the supply air. Continual airflow variations to follow load changes in the building can create wide and rapid swings in space humidity. Because of the fast-changing nature and cooler supply air temperatures (13°C or lower) of most VAV systems, special modulating humidity controls should be applied.

Best results are obtained by using both space and duct modulating humidity sensors with an integrating device, which in turn modulates the output of the humidifier. This allows the duct sensor to respond quickly to a rapid rise in duct humidity caused when airflow to the space decreases as temperature conditions are satisfied. The duct sensor at times overrides the space humidistat by reducing the humidifier output to correspond to decreasing air volumes. This type of system, commonly referred to as **anticipating control**, allows the humidifier to track the dynamics of the system and provide uniform control. Because of the operating duct static pressures of a VAV system, using an **airflow proving device** is recommended to detect air movement.

Commissioning Systems

Each individual humidifier should have a dedicated space control, high-limit humidistat, and air proving switch. All should be calibrated and checked for accurate control capabilities when commissioning the system and periodically as recommended by the control manufacturer. Properly commissioning the humidification system according to the manufacturer's instructions is essential for long-term reliability, sustainability, performance, and ultimately owner satisfaction with the system.

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CHAPTER 23

AIR-COOLING AND DEHUMIDIFYING COILS

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MOST equipment used today for cooling and dehumidifying an airstream under forced convection incorporates a coil section that contains one or more cooling coils assembled in a coil bank arrangement. Such coil sections are used extensively as components in room terminal units; larger factory-assembled, self-contained air conditioners; central station air handlers; and field built-up systems. Applications of each coil type are limited to the field within which the coil is rated. Other limitations are imposed by code requirements, proper choice of materials for the fluids used, the configuration of the air handler, and economic analysis of the possible alternatives for each installation.

1. USES FOR COILS

Coils are used for air cooling with or without accompanying dehumidification. Examples of cooling applications without dehumidification are (1) precooling coils that use well water or other relatively high-temperature water to reduce load on the refrigerating equipment and (2) chilled-water coils that remove sensible heat from chemical moisture-absorption apparatus. The heat pipe coil is also used as a supplementary heat exchanger for preconditioning in air-side sensible cooling (see Chapter 26). Most coil sections provide air sensible cooling and dehumidification simultaneously.

The assembly usually includes a means of cleaning air to protect the coil from dirt accumulation and to keep dust and foreign matter out of the conditioned space. Although cooling and dehumidification are their principal functions, cooling coils can also be wetted with water or a hygroscopic liquid to aid in air cleaning, odor absorption, or frost prevention. Coils are also evaporatively cooled with a water spray to improve efficiency or capacity. Chapter 41 has more information on indirect evaporative cooling. For general comfort conditioning, cooling, and dehumidifying, the **extended-surface (finned) cooling coil** design is the most popular and practical.

2. COIL CONSTRUCTION AND ARRANGEMENT

In finned coils, the external surface of the tubes is primary, and the fin surface is secondary. The primary surface generally consists of rows of round tubes or pipes that may be staggered or placed in line with respect to the airflow. Flattened tubes or tubes with other nonround internal passageways are sometimes used. The inside surface of the tubes is usually smooth and plain, but some coil designs have various forms of internal fins or turbulence promoters (either fabricated or extruded) to enhance performance. The individual tube passes in a coil are usually interconnected by return bends (or hairpin bend tubes) to form the serpentine arrangement of multipass tube circuits. Coils are usually available with different circuit arrangements and combinations offering varying numbers of parallel water flow passes within the tube core (Figure 1).

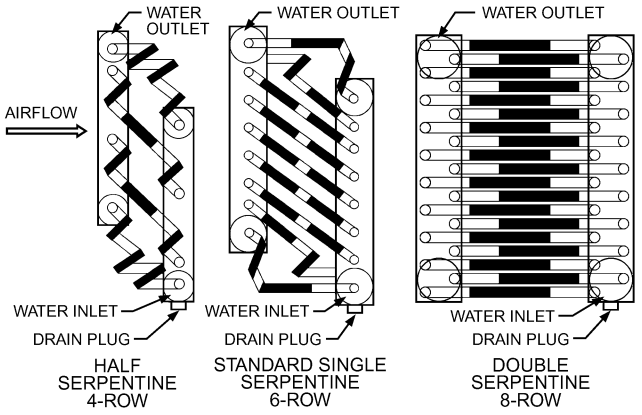

Fig. 1 Typical Water Circuit Arrangements

Cooling coils for water, aqueous glycol, brine, or halocarbon refrigerants usually have aluminum fins on copper tubes, although copper fins on copper tubes and aluminum fins on aluminum tubes (excluding water) are also used. Adhesives are sometimes used to bond header connections, return bends, and fin-tube joints, particularly for aluminum-to-aluminum joints. Certain special-application coils feature an all-aluminum extruded tube-and-fin surface.

Common core tube outside diameters are 8, 10, 12.5, 16, 20, and 25 mm, with fins spaced 1.4 to 6.4 mm apart. Tube spacing ranges from 15 to 75 mm on equilateral (staggered) or rectangular (in-line) centers, depending on the width of individual fins and on other performance considerations. Fins should be spaced according to the job to be performed, with special attention given to air friction; possibility of lint accumulation; and frost accumulation, especially at lower temperatures.

Tube wall thickness and the required use of alloys other than copper are determined mainly by the coil's working pressure and safety factor for hydrostatic burst (pressure). Maximum allowable working pressure (MAWP) for a coil is derived according to ASME's *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*, Section VIII, Division 1 and Section II (ASTM material properties and stress tables). Pressure vessel safety standards compliance and certifications of coil construction may be required by regional and local codes before field installation. Fin type and header construction also play a large part in determining wall thickness and material. Local job site codes and applicable nationally recognized safety standards should be consulted in coil design and application.

This type of air-cooling coil normally has a shiny aluminum airside surface. For special applications, the fin surface may be copper or have a brown or blue-green dip-process coating. These coatings protect the fin from oxidation that occurs when common airborne corrosive contaminants are diluted on a wet (dehumidifying) surface. Corrosion protection is increasingly important as indoor air quality (IAQ) guidelines call for higher percentages of outdoor air. Baked-on or anodized coating improves the expected service life

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.4, Air-to-Refrigerant Heat Transfer Equipment.

compared to plain aluminum fins under similar conditions. Uncoated fins on non-dehumidifying, dry cooling coils are generally not affected by normal ambient airborne chemicals, except, to some extent, in a saline atmosphere. Once the coil is installed, little can be done to improve air-side protection.

Incoming airstream stratification across the coil face reduces coil performance. Proper air distribution is defined as having a measured airflow anywhere on the coil face that does not vary more than 20%. Moisture carryover at the coil's air leaving side or uneven air filter loading are indications of uneven airflow through the coil. Normal corrective procedure is to install inlet air straighteners, or an air blender if several airstreams converge at the coil inlet face. Additionally, condensate water should never be allowed to saturate the duct liner or stand in the drain pan (trough). The coil frame (particularly its bottom sheet metal member) should not be allowed to sit in a pool of water, to prevent rusting.

Water and Aqueous Glycol Coils

Good performance of water-type coils requires both eliminating all air and water traps in the water circuit and the proper distribution of water. Unless properly vented, air may accumulate in the coil tube circuits, reducing thermal performance and possibly causing noise or vibration in the piping system. Air vent and drain connections are usually provided on coil water headers, but this does not eliminate the need to install, operate, and maintain the coil tube core in a level position. Individual coil vents and drain plugs are often incorporated on the headers (Figure 1). Water traps in tubing of a properly leveled coil are usually caused by (1) improper nondraining circuit design and/or (2) center-of-coil downward sag. Such a situation may cause tube failure (e.g., freeze-up in cold climates, tube erosion because of untreated mineralized water).

Depending on performance requirements, fluid velocity inside the tube usually ranges from approximately 0.3 to 2.4 m/s for water and 0.15 to 1.8 m/s for glycol. When turbulators or grooved tubes are used, in-tube velocities should not exceed 1.2 m/s. The design fluid pressure drop across the coils varies from about 15 to 150 kPa. For nuclear HVAC applications, ASME *Standard* AG-1 requires a minimum tube velocity of 0.6 m/s. AHRI *Standard* 410 requires a minimum of 0.3 m/s or a Reynolds number of 3100 or greater. This yields more predictable performance.

In certain cases, the water may contain considerable sand and other foreign matter (e.g., precooling coils using well water, or where minerals in the cooling water deposit on and foul the tube surface). It is best to filter out such sediment. Some coil manufacturers offer removable water header plates or a removable plug for each tube that allows the tube to be cleaned, ensuring continuing rated performance while the cooling units are in service. Where build-up of scale deposits or fouling of the water-side surface is expected, a scale factor is sometimes included when calculating thermal performance of the coils. Cupronickel, red brass, bronze, and other tube alloys help protect against corrosion and erosion deterioration caused primarily by internal fluid flow abrasive sediment. The core tubes of properly designed and installed coils should feature circuits that (1) have equally developed line length, (2) are self-draining by gravity during the coil's off cycle, (3) have the minimum pressure drop to aid water distribution from the supply header without requiring excessive pumping pressure, and (4) have equal feed and return by the supply and return header. Design for proper in-tube water velocity determines the circuitry style required. Multirow coils are usually circuited to the cross-counterflow arrangement and oriented for top-outlet/bottom-feed connection.

Direct-Expansion Coils

Coils for halocarbon refrigerants present more complex cooling fluid distribution problems than do water or brine coils. The coil should cool effectively and uniformly throughout, with even refrigerant distribution. Halocarbon coils are used on two types of refrigerated systems: flooded and direct-expansion.

A flooded system is used mainly when a small temperature difference between the air and refrigerant is desired. Chapter 2 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* describes flooded systems in more detail.

For direct-expansion systems, two of the most commonly used refrigerant liquid metering arrangements are the capillary tube assembly (or restrictor orifice) and the thermostatic expansion valve (TXV) device. The **capillary tube** is applied in factory-assembled, self-contained air conditioners up to approximately 35 kW capacity, but is most widely used on smaller-capacity models such as window or room units. In this system, the bore and length of a capillary tube are sized so that at full load, under design conditions, just enough liquid refrigerant to be evaporated completely is metered from the condenser to the evaporator coil. Although this type of metering arrangement does not operate over a wide range of conditions as efficiently as a TXV system, its performance is targeted for a specific design condition.

A **thermostatic expansion valve** system is commonly used for all direct-expansion coil applications described in this chapter, particularly field-assembled coil sections and those used in central air-handling units and larger, factory-assembled hermetic air conditioners. This system depends on the TXV to automatically regulate the rate of refrigerant liquid flow to the coil in direct proportion to the evaporation rate of refrigerant liquid in the coil, thereby maintaining optimum performance over a wide range of conditions. Superheat at the coil suction outlet is continually maintained within the usual predetermined limits of 3 to 6 K. Because the TXV responds to the superheat at the coil outlet, superheat within the coil is produced with the least possible sacrifice of active evaporating surface.

The length of each coil's refrigerant circuits, from the TXV's distributor feed tubes through the suction header, should be equal. The length of each circuit should be optimized to provide good heat transfer, good oil return, and a complementary pressure drop across the circuit. The coil should be installed level, and coil circuitry should be designed to self-drain by gravity toward the suction header connection. This is especially important on systems with unloaders or variable-speed-drive compressor(s). When non-self-drain circuitry is used, the circuit and suction connection should be designed for a minimum tube velocity sufficient to avoid compressor lube oil trapping in the coil.

To ensure reasonably uniform refrigerant distribution in multicircuit coils, a distributor is placed between the TXV and coil inlets to divide refrigerant equally among the coil circuits. The refrigerant distributor must be effective in distributing both liquid and vapor because refrigerant entering the coil is usually a mixture of the two, although mainly liquid by mass. Distributors can be placed either vertically or horizontally; however, the vertical down position usually distributes refrigerant between coil circuits better than the horizontal for varying load conditions.

Individual coil circuit connections from the refrigerant distributor to the coil inlet are made of small-diameter tubing; the connections are all the same length and diameter so that the same flow occurs between each refrigerant distributor tube and each coil circuit. To approximate uniform refrigerant distribution, refrigerant should flow to each refrigerant distributor circuit in proportion to the load on that coil. The heat load must be distributed equally to each refrigerant circuit for optimum coil performance. If the coil load cannot be distributed uniformly, the coil should be recircuited and connected with more than one TXV to feed the circuits (individual suction may also help). In this way, refrigerant distribution is reduced in proportion to the number of distributors to have less effect on overall coil performance when design must accommodate some unequal circuit loading. Unequal circuit loading may also be caused by uneven air velocity across the coil's face, uneven entering air temperature,

improper coil circuiting, oversized orifice in distributor, or the TXV's not being directly connected (close-coupled) to the distributor.

Control of Coils

Cooling capacity of water coils is controlled by varying either water flow or airflow. Water flow can be controlled by a three-way mixing, modulating, and/or throttling valve. For airflow control, face and bypass dampers are used. When cooling demand decreases, the coil face damper starts to close, and the bypass damper opens. In some cases, airflow is varied by controlling fan capacity with speed controls, inlet vanes, or discharge dampers.

Chapter 47 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* addresses air-cooling coil control to meet system or space requirements and factors to consider when sizing automatic valves for water coils. Selection and application of refrigerant flow control devices (e.g., thermostatic expansion valves, capillary tube types, constant-pressure expansion valves, evaporator pressure regulators, suction-pressure regulators, solenoid valves) as used with direct-expansion coils are discussed in Chapter 11 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

For factory-assembled, self-contained packaged systems or field-assembled systems using direct-expansion coils equipped with TXVs, a single valve is sometimes used for each coil; in other cases, two or more valves are used. The thermostatic expansion valve controls the refrigerant flow rate through the coil circuits so refrigerant vapor at the coil outlet is superheated properly. Superheat is obtained with suitable coil design and proper valve selection. Unlike water flow control valves, standard pressure/temperature thermostatic expansion valves alone do not control the refrigeration system's capacity or the temperature of the leaving air, nor do they maintain ambient conditions in specific spaces. However, some electronically controlled TXVs have these attributes.

To match refrigeration load requirements for the conditioned space to the cooling capacity of the coil(s), a thermostat located in the conditioned space(s) or in the return air temporarily interrupts refrigerant flow to the direct-expansion cooling coils by stopping the compressor(s) and/or closing the solenoid liquid-line valve(s). Other solenoids unload compressors by suction control. For jobs with only a single zone of conditioned space, the compressor's on/off control is frequently used to modulate coil capacity. Selection and application of evaporator pressure regulators and similar regulators that are temperature-operated and respond to the temperature of conditioned air are covered in Chapter 11 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

Applications with multiple zones of conditioned space often use solenoid liquid-line valves to vary coil capacity. These valves should be used where thermostatic expansion valves feed certain types (or sections) of evaporator coils that may, according to load variations, require a temporary but positive interruption of refrigerant flow. This applies particularly to multiple evaporator coils in a unit where one or more must be shut off temporarily to regulate its zone capacity. In such cases, a solenoid valve should be installed directly upstream of the thermostatic expansion valve(s). If more than one expansion valve feeds a particular zone coil, they may all be controlled by a single solenoid valve.

For a coil controlled by multiple refrigerant expansion valves, there are three arrangements: (1) face control, in which the coil is divided across its face; (2) row control; and (3) interlaced circuitry (Figure 2).

Face control, which is the most widely used because of its simplicity, equally loads all refrigerant circuits in the coil. Face control has the disadvantage of allowing condensate reevaporation on the coil portion not in operation and bypassing air into the conditioned space during partial-load conditions, when some of the TXVs are off. However, while the bottom portion of the coil is cooling, some of the advantages of single-zone humidity control can be achieved with air bypasses through the inactive top portion.

Row control, seldom available as standard equipment, eliminates air bypassing during partial-load operation and minimizes condensate reevaporation. Close attention is required for accurate calculation of row-depth capacity, circuit design, and TXV sizing.

Interlaced circuit control uses the whole face area and depth of coil when some expansion valves are shut off. Without a corresponding drop in airflow, modulating refrigerant flow to an interlaced coil increases coil surface temperature, thereby necessitating compressor protection (e.g., suction pressure regulators or compressor multiplexing).

Flow Arrangement

In air conditioning, the relation of the fluid flow arrangement in the coil tubes to coil depth greatly influences performance of the heat transfer surface. Generally, air-cooling and dehumidifying coils are multirow and circuited for **counterflow** arrangement. Inlet air is applied at right angles to the coil's tube face (coil height), which is also at the coil's outlet header location. Air exits at the opposite face (side) of the coil where the corresponding inlet header is located. Counterflow can produce the highest possible heat exchange in the shortest possible (coil row) depth because it has the closest temperature relationships between tube fluid and air at each (air) side of the coil; the temperature of the entering air more closely approaches the temperature of the leaving fluid than the temperature of the leaving air approaches the temperature of the entry fluid. The potential of realizing the highest possible mean temperature difference is thus arranged for optimum performance.

Most direct-expansion coils also follow this general scheme of thermal counterflow, but proper superheat control may require a hybrid combination of parallel flow and counterflow. (Air flows in the same direction as the refrigerant in parallel-flow operation.) Often, the optimum design for large coils is parallel flow in the coil's initial (entry) boiling region followed by counterflow in the superheat (exit) region. Such a hybrid arrangement is commonly used for process applications that require a low temperature difference (low TD).

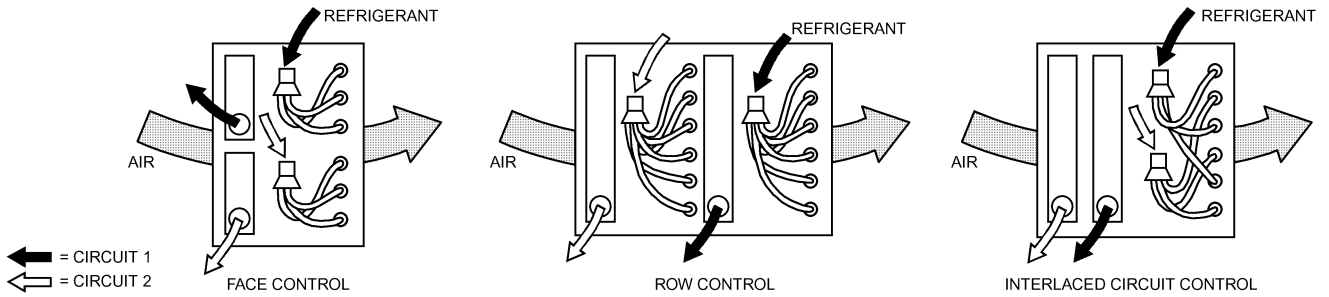

Fig. 2 Arrangements for Coils with Multiple Thermostatic Expansion Valves

Coil hand refers to either the right hand (RH) or left hand (LH) for counterflow arrangement of a multirow counterflow coil. There is no convention for what constitutes LH or RH, so manufacturers usually establish a convention for their own coils. Most manufacturers designate the location of the inlet water header or refrigerant distributor as the coil hand reference point. Figure 3 shows the more widely accepted coil hand designation for multirow water or refrigerant coils.

Applications

Figure 4 shows a typical arrangement of coils in a field built-up central station system. All air should be filtered to prevent dirt, insects, and foreign matter from accumulating on the coils. The cooling coil (and humidifier, when used) should include a drain pan under each coil to catch condensate formed during cooling (and excess water from the humidifier). The drain connection should be downstream of the coils, be of ample size, have accessible cleanouts, and discharge to an indirect waste or storm sewer. The drain also requires a deep-seal trap so that no sewer gas can enter the system. Precautions must be taken if there is a possibility that the drain might freeze. The drain pan, unit casing, and water piping should be insulated to prevent sweating.

Factory-assembled central station air handlers incorporate most of the design features outlined for field built-up systems. These packaged units can generally accommodate various sizes, types, and row depths of cooling and heating coils to meet most job requirements. This usually eliminates the need for field built-up central systems, except on very large jobs.

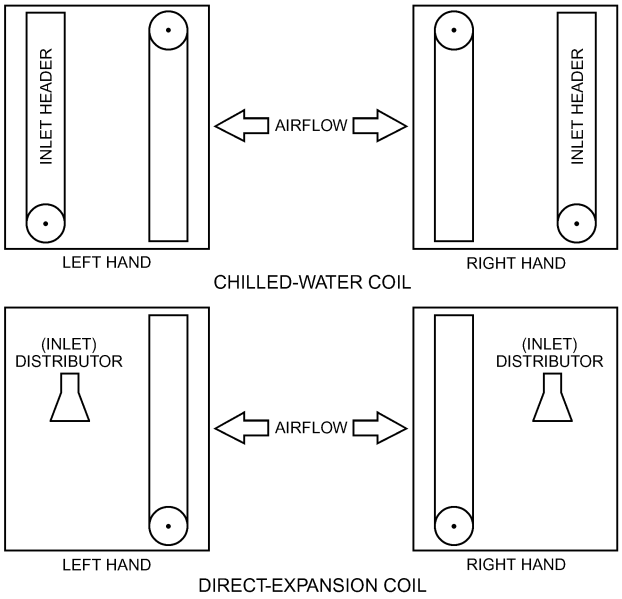

Fig. 3 Typical Coil Hand Designation

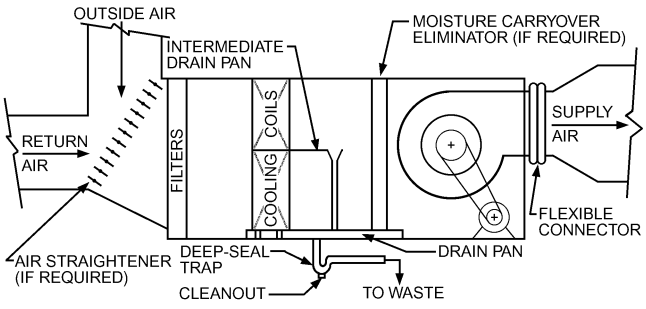

Fig. 4 Typical Arrangement of Cooling Coil Assembly in Built-Up or Packaged Central Station Air Handler

The coil's design features (fin spacing, tube spacing, face height, type of fins), together with the amount of moisture on the coil and the degree of surface cleanliness, determine the air velocity at which condensed moisture blows off the coil. Generally, condensate water begins to be blown off a plate fin coil face at air velocities above 3 m/s. Water blowoff from coils into air ductwork external to the air-conditioning unit should be prevented. However, water blowoff is not usually a problem if coil fin heights are limited to 1140 mm and the unit is set up to catch and dispose of condensate. When a number of coils are stacked one above another, condensate is carried into the airstream as it drips from one coil to the next. A downstream eliminator section could prevent this, but an intermediate drain pan and/or condensate trough (Figure 5) to collect the condensate and conduct it directly to the main drain pan is preferred. Extending downstream of the coil, each drain pan length should be at least one-half the coil height, and somewhat greater when coil airflow face velocities and/or humidity levels are higher.

When water is likely to carry over from the air-conditioning unit into external air ductwork, and no other means of prevention is provided, eliminator plates should be installed downstream of the coils. Usually, eliminator plates are not included in packaged units because other means of preventing carryover, such as space made available within the unit design for longer drain pan(s), are included in the design.

However, on sprayed-coil units (Figure 6), eliminators are usually included in the design. Such cooling and dehumidifying coils are sometimes sprayed with water to increase the rate of heat transfer, provide outlet air approaching saturation, and continually wash the surface of the coil. Coil sprays require a collecting tank, eliminators, and a recirculating pump. Figure 6 also shows an air bypass, which helps a thermostat control maintain the humidity ratio by diverting a portion of the return air from the coil.

In field-assembled systems or factory-assembled central station air-handling units, fans are usually positioned downstream from the coil(s) in a draw-through arrangement. This arrangement provides acceptable airflow uniformity across the coil face more often than does the blow-through arrangement. In a blow-through arrangement, fans upstream from the coils may require air baffles or diffuser plates between the fan discharge and cooling coil to obtain uniform airflow. This is often the case in packaged multizone unit

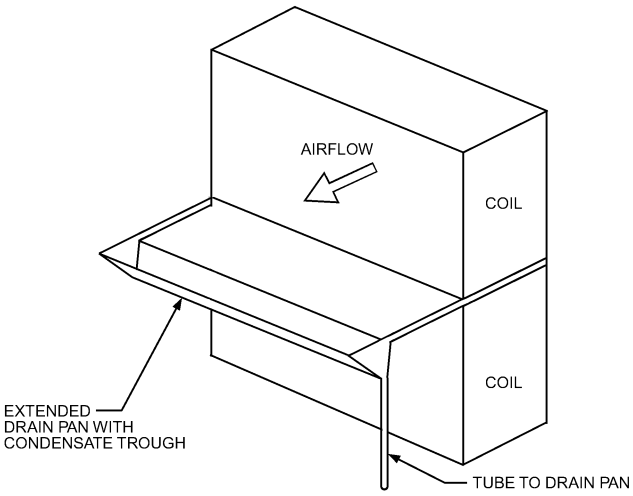

Fig. 5 Coil Bank Arrangement with Intermediate Condensate Pan

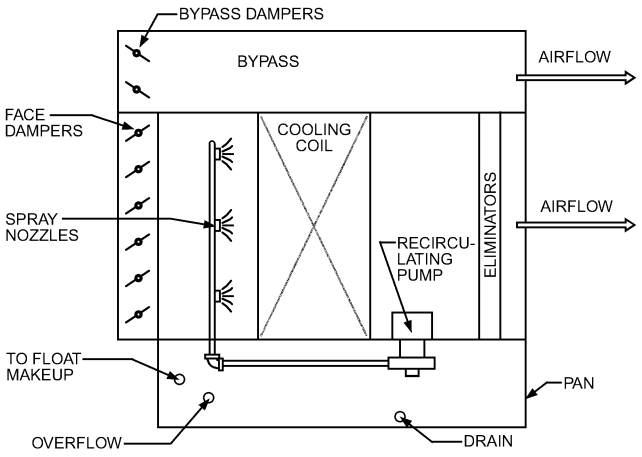

Fig. 6 Sprayed-Coil System with Air Bypass

design. Airflow is considered to be uniform when measured flow across the entire coil face varies no more than 20%.

Air-cooling and dehumidifying coil frames, as well as all drain pans and troughs, should be of an acceptable corrosion-resistant material suitable for the system and its expected useful service life. The air handler's coil section enclosure should be corrosion resistant; be properly double-wall insulated; and have adequate access doors for changing air filters, cleaning coils, adjusting flow control valves, and maintaining motors.

Where suction line risers are used for air-cooling coils in direct-expansion refrigeration systems, the suction line must be sized properly to ensure oil return from coil to compressor at minimum load conditions. Oil return is normally intrinsic with factory-assembled, self-contained air conditioners but must be considered for factory-assembled central station units or field-installed cooling coil banks where suction line risers are required and are assembled at the job site. Sizing, design, and arrangement of suction lines and their risers are described in Chapter 2 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

3. COIL SELECTION

When selecting a coil, consider the following factors:

- Job requirements: cooling, dehumidifying, and capacity required to properly balance with other system components (e.g., compressor equipment in the case of direct-expansion coils)
- Entering air dry-bulb and wet-bulb temperatures
- Available cooling media and operating temperatures
- Space and dimensional limitations
- Air and cooling fluid quantities, including distribution and limitations
- Allowable frictional resistances in air circuit (including coils)
- Allowable frictional resistances in cooling media piping system (including coils)
- Characteristics of individual coil designs and circuitry possibilities
- Individual installation requirements such as type of automatic control to be used; presence of corrosive atmosphere; design pressures; and durability of tube, fins, and frame material

Chapters 17 and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* provide information on load calculation.

Air quantity is affected by factors such as design parameters, codes, space, and equipment. Resistance through the air circuit influences fan power and speed. This resistance may be limited to allow the use of a given size fan motor, to keep operating expense low, or because of sound-level requirements. Air friction loss across the cooling coil (in summation with other series air-pressure drops for elements such as air filters, water sprays, heating coils, air grilles, and ductwork) determines the static pressure requirement for the complete airway system. The static pressure requirement is used in selecting fans and drives to obtain the design air quantity under operating conditions. See Chapter 21 for a description of fan selection.

The conditioned-air face velocity is determined by economic evaluation of initial and operating costs for the complete installation as influenced by (1) heat transfer performance of the specific coil surface type for various combinations of face areas and row depths as a function of air velocity; (2) air-side frictional resistance for the complete air circuit (including coils), which affects fan size, power, and sound-level requirements; and (3) condensate water carryover considerations. Allowable friction through the water or brine coil circuitry may be dictated by the pressure available from a given size pump and pump motor, as well as the same economic factors governing the air side made applicable to the water side. Additionally, the adverse effect of high cooling-water velocities on erosion/corrosion of tube walls is a major factor in sizing and circuitry to keep tube velocity below the recommended maximums. On larger coils, water pressure drop limits of 45 to 60 kPa usually keep such velocities within acceptable limits of 0.6 to 1.2 m/s, depending on circuit design.

Coil ratings are based on a uniform velocity. Design interference with uniform airflow through the coil makes predicting coil performance difficult as well as inaccurate. Such airflow interference may be caused by air entering at odd angles or by inadvertent partial blocking of the coil face. To obtain rated performance, the volumetric airflow quantity must be adjusted on the job to that at which the coil was rated and must be kept at that value. At start-up for air balance, the most common causes of incorrect airflow are the lack of altitude correction to standard air (where applicable) and ductwork problems. At commissioning, the most common causes of an air quantity deficiency are filter fouling and dirt or frost collection on the coils. These difficulties can be avoided through proper design, start-up checkout, and regular servicing.

The required total heat capacity of the cooling coil should be in balance with the capacity of other refrigerant system components such as the compressor, water chiller, condenser, and refrigerant liquid metering device. Chapter 5 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* describes methods of estimating balanced system capacity under various operating conditions when using direct-expansion coils for both factory- and field-assembled systems.

For dehumidifying coils, it is important that the proper amount of surface area be installed to obtain the ratio of air-side sensible-to-total heat required to maintain air dry-bulb and wet-bulb temperatures in the conditioned space. This is an important consideration when preconditioning is done by reheat arrangement. The method for calculating the sensible and total heat loads and leaving-air conditions at the coil to satisfy the sensible-to-total heat ratio required for the conditioned space is covered in Appendix D of *Cooling and Heating Load Calculation Principles* (Pedersen et al. 1998).

The same room air conditions can be maintained with different air quantities (including outdoor and return air) through a coil. However, for a given total air quantity with fixed percentages of outdoor and return air, there is only one set of air conditions leaving the coil that will precisely maintain room design air conditions. Once air quantity and leaving-air conditions at the coil have been selected, there is usually only one combination of face area, row depth, and air face velocity for a given coil surface that will precisely maintain the required room ambient conditions. Therefore, in making final coil selections it is necessary to recheck the initial selection to ensure that the leaving-air conditions, as calculated by a coil selection computer program or other procedure, match those determined from the cooling load estimate.

Coil ratings and selections can be obtained from manufacturers' catalogs. Most catalogs contain extensive tables giving the performance of coils at various air and water velocities and entering humidity and temperatures. Most manufacturers provide computerized coil selection programs to potential customers. The final choice can then be made based on system performance and economic requirements.

Performance and Ratings

The long-term performance of an extended-surface air-cooling and dehumidifying coil depends on its correct design to specified conditions and material specifications, proper matching to other system components, proper installation, and proper maintenance as required.

In accordance with AHRI *Standard* 410, dry-surface (sensible cooling) coils and dehumidifying coils (which both cool and dehumidify), particularly those for field-assembled coil banks or factory-assembled packaged units using different combinations of coils, are usually rated within the following parameters:

Entering air dry-bulb temperature: 18 to 38°C
Entering air wet-bulb temperature: 15 to 30°C (if air is not dehumidified in the application, select coils based on sensible heat transfer)
Air face velocity: 1 to 4 m/s
Evaporator refrigerant saturation temperature: –1 to 13°C at coil suction outlet (refrigerant vapor superheat at coil suction outlet is 3 K or higher)
Entering chilled-water temperature: 1.5 to 18°C
Water velocity: 0.3 to 2.4 m/s
For ethylene glycol solution: 0.3 to 1.8 m/s, –18 to 32°C entering dry-bulb temperature, 15 to 27°C entering wet-bulb temperature, 10 to 60% aqueous glycol concentration by mass

The air-side ratio of sensible to total heat removed by dehumidifying coils varies in practice from about 0.6 to 1.0 (i.e., sensible heat is from 60 to 100% of the total, depending on the application). For information on calculating a dehumidifying coil's sensible heat ratio, see the section on Performance of Dehumidifying Coils, or Appendix D of *Cooling and Heating Load Calculation Principles* (Pedersen et al. 1998). For a given coil surface design and arrangement, the required sensible heat ratio may be satisfied by wide variations in and combinations of air face velocity, in-tube temperature, flow rate, entering air temperature, coil depth, etc., although the variations may be self limiting. The maximum coil air face velocity should be limited to a value that prevents water carryover into the air ductwork. Dehumidifying coils for comfort applications are frequently selected in the range of 2.0 to 2.5 m/s air face velocity.

Operating ratings of dehumidifying coils for factory-assembled, self-contained air conditioners are generally determined in conjunction with laboratory testing for the system capacity of the complete unit assembly. For example, a standard rating point has been 54 L/s per kilowatt of refrigeration effect, not to exceed 60 L/s per kilowatt for unitary equipment. Refrigerant (e.g., R-22) duty would be 3 to 6 K superheat for an appropriate balance at 7°C saturated suction. For water coils, circuitry would operate at 1.2 m/s, 5.5°C inlet water, 6.7 K rise (or 36 mL/s per kilowatt of refrigeration effect). The standard ratings at 26.7°C db and 19.5°C wb are representative of the entering air conditions encountered in many comfort operations. Although indoor conditions are usually lower than 19.5°C wb, it is usually assumed that introducing outdoor air brings the air mixture to the cooling coil up to about 26.7°C db/19.5°C wb entering air design conditions.

Dehumidifying coils for field-assembled projects and central station air-handling units were formerly selected according to coil rating tables but are now selected by computerized selection programs. Either way, selecting coils from the load division indicated by the load calculation works satisfactorily for the usual human comfort applications. Additional design precautions and refinements are necessary for more exacting industrial applications and for all types of air conditioning in humid areas. One such refinement, the dual-path air process, uses a separate cooling coil to cool and dehumidify ventilation air before mixing it with recirculated air. This process dehumidifies what is usually the main source of moisture: makeup outdoor air. Condenser heat reclaim (when available) is another refinement required for some industrial applications and is finding greater use in commercial and comfort applications.

Airflow ratings are based on standard air of 1.20 kg/m^3 at 20°C and a barometric pressure of 101.325 kPa. In some mountainous areas with a sufficiently large market, coil ratings and altitude-corrected psychrometrics are available for their particular altitudes.

When checking the operation of dehumidifying coils, climatic conditions must be considered. Most problems are encountered at light-load conditions, when the cooling requirement is considerably less than at design conditions. In hot, dry climates, where the outdoor dew point is consistently low, dehumidifying is not generally a problem, and the light-load design point condition does not pose any special problems. In hot, humid climates, the light-load condition has a higher proportion of moisture and a correspondingly lower proportion of sensible heat. The result is higher dew points in the conditioned spaces during light-load conditions unless a special means for controlling inside dew points (e.g., reheat or dual path) is used.

Fin surface freezing at light loads should be avoided. Freezing occurs when a dehumidification coil's surface temperature falls below 0°C. Freezing does not occur with standard coils for comfort installations unless the refrigerant evaporating temperature at the coil outlet is below –4 to –2°C saturated; the exact value depends on the design of the coil, its operating dew point, and the amount of loading. With coil and condensing units to balance at low temperatures at peak loads (not a customary design choice), freezing may occur when load suddenly decreases. The possibility of this type of surface freezing is greater if a bypass is used because it causes less air to be passed through the coil at light loads.

4. AIRFLOW RESISTANCE

A cooling coil's airflow resistance (air friction) depends on the tube pattern and fin geometry (tube size and spacing, fin configuration, and number of in-line or staggered rows), coil face velocity, and amount of moisture on the coil. The coil air friction may also be affected by the degree of aerodynamic cleanliness of the coil core; burrs on fin edges may increase coil friction and increase the tendency to pocket dirt or lint on the faces. A completely dry coil, removing only sensible heat, offers approximately one-third less resistance to airflow than a dehumidifying coil removing both sensible and latent heat.

For a given surface and airflow, increasing the number of rows or fins increases airflow resistance. Therefore, final selection involves economic balancing of the initial cost of the coil against the operating costs of the coil geometry combinations available to adequately meet the performance requirements.

The aluminum fin surfaces of new dehumidifying coils tend to inhibit condensate sheeting action until they have aged for a year. Hydrophilic aluminum fin surface coatings reduce water droplet surface tension, producing a more evenly dispersed wetted surface action at initial start-up. Manufacturers have tried different methods of applying such coatings, including dipping the coil into a tank, coating the fin stock material, or subjecting the material to a chemical etching process. Tests have shown as much as a 30% reduction in air pressure drop across a hydrophilic coil as opposed a new untreated coil.

5. HEAT TRANSFER

The heat transmission rate of air passing over a clean tube (with or without extended surface) to a fluid flowing in it is impeded principally by three thermal resistances: (1) surface air-side film thermal resistance from the air to the surface of the exterior fin and tube assembly; (2) metal thermal resistance to heat conductance through the exterior fin and tube assembly; and (3) in-tube fluid-side film thermal resistance, which impedes heat flow between the internal surface of the metal and the fluid flowing within the tube. For some applications, an additional thermal resistance is factored in to account for external and/or internal surface fouling. Usually, the combination of metal and tube-side film resistance is considerably lower than the air-side surface resistance.

For a reduction in thermal resistance, the fin surface is fabricated with die-formed corrugations instead of the traditional flat design. At low airflows or wide fin spacing, the air-side transfer coefficient is virtually the same for flat and corrugated fins. Under normal comfort conditioning operation, the corrugated fin surface is designed to reduce the boundary air film thickness by undulating the passing airstream within the coil; this produces a marked improvement in heat transfer without much airflow penalty. Further fin enhancements, including louvered and lanced fin designs, have been driven by the desire to duplicate throughout the coil depth the thin boundary air film characteristic of the fin's leading edge. Louvered fin design maximizes the number of fin surface leading edges throughout the entire secondary surface area and increases the external secondary surface area A_s through the multiplicity of edges.

Where an application allows economical use of coil construction materials, the mass and size of the coil can be reduced when boundary air and water films are lessened. For example, the exterior surface resistance can be reduced to nearly the same as the fluid-side resistance by using lanced and/or louvered fins. External as well as internal tube fins (or internal turbulators) can economically decrease overall heat transfer surface resistances. Also, water sprays applied to a flat fin coil surface may increase overall heat transfer slightly, although they may better serve other purposes such as air and coil cleaning.

Heat transfer between the cooling medium and the airstream across a coil is influenced by the following variables:

- Temperature difference between fluids
- Design and surface arrangement of coil
- Velocity and character of airstream
- Velocity and character of in-tube coolant

With water coils, only the water temperature rises. With coils of volatile refrigerants, an appreciable pressure drop and a corresponding change in evaporating temperature through the refrigerant circuit often occur. Alternative refrigerants to R-22, such as R-407C, which has a temperature glide, have an evaporation temperature rise of 4 to 7 K through the evaporator. This must be considered in design and performance calculation of the coil. A compensating pressure drop in the coil may partially, or even totally, compensate for the low-side temperature glide of a zeotropic refrigerant blend. Rating direct-expansion coils is further complicated by the refrigerant evaporating in part of the circuit and superheating in the remainder. Thus, for halocarbon refrigerants, a cooling coil is tested and rated with a specific distributing and liquid-metering device, and the capacities are stated with the superheat condition of the leaving vapor.

At a given air mass velocity, performance depends on the turbulence of airflow into the coil and the uniformity of air distribution over the coil face. The latter is necessary to obtain reliable test ratings and realize rated performance in actual installations. Air resistance through the coils helps distribute air properly, but the effect is frequently inadequate where inlet duct connections are brought in at sharp angles to the coil face. Reverse air currents may pass through a portion of the coils. These currents reduce capacity but can be avoided with proper inlet air vanes or baffles. Air blades may also be required. Remember that coil performance ratings (AHRI *Standard* 410) represent optimum conditions resulting from adequate and reliable laboratory tests (ASHRAE *Standard* 33).

For cases when available data must be extended, for arriving at general design criteria for a single, unique installation, or for understanding the calculation progression, the following material and illustrative examples for calculating cooling coil performance are useful guides.

6. PERFORMANCE OF SENSIBLE COOLING COILS

The performance of sensible cooling coils depends on the following factors. See the section on Symbols for an explanation of the variables.

- The overall coefficient U_o of sensible heat transfer between airstream and coolant fluid
- The mean temperature difference Δt_m between airstream and coolant fluid
- The physical dimensions of and data for the coil (such as coil face area A_a and total external surface area A_o) with characteristics of the heat transfer surface

The sensible heat cooling capacity q_{td} of a given coil is expressed by the following equation:

$$q_{td} = U_o F_s A_a N_r \Delta t_m \tag{1a}$$

with

$$F_s = A_o / A_a N_r \tag{1b}$$

Assuming no extraneous heat losses, the same amount of sensible heat is lost from the airstream:

$$q_{td} = 1000 w_a c_p (t_{a1} - t_{a2}) \tag{2a}$$

with

$$w_a = 60 \rho_a A_a V_a \tag{2b}$$

The same amount of sensible heat is absorbed by the coolant; for a nonvolatile type, it is

$$q_{td} = 1000 w_r c_r (t_{r2} - t_{r1}) \tag{3}$$

For a nonvolatile coolant in thermal counterflow with the air, the mean temperature difference in Equation (1a) is expressed as

$$\Delta t_m = \frac{(t_{a1} - t_{r2}) - (t_{a2} - t_{r1})}{\ln[(t_{a1} - t_{r2}) / (t_{a2} - t_{r1})]} \tag{4}$$

Proper temperature differences for various cross-flow situations are given in many texts, including Mueller (1973). These calculations are based on various assumptions, among them that U for the total external surface is constant. Although this assumption is generally not valid for multirow coils, using cross-flow temperature differences from Mueller (1973) or other texts should be preferable to Equation (4), which applies only to counterflow. However, using the log mean temperature difference is widespread.

The overall heat transfer coefficient U_o for a given coil design, whether bare-pipe or finned-type, with clean, nonfouled surfaces, consists of the combined effect of three individual heat transfer coefficients:

- The **film coefficient f_a** of sensible heat transfer between air and the external surface of the coil
- The **unit conductance $1/R_{md}$** of the coil material (i.e., tube wall, fins, tube-to-fin thermal resistance)
- The **film coefficient f_r** of heat transfer between the internal coil surface and the coolant fluid within the coil

These three individual coefficients acting in series form an overall coefficient of heat transfer in accordance with the material given in Chapters 4 and 25 to 27 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

For a bare-pipe coil, the overall coefficient of heat transfer for sensible cooling (without dehumidification) can be expressed by a simplified basic equation:

$$U_o = \frac{1}{(1/f_a) + (D_o - D_i)/2000k + (B/f_r)} \quad (5a)$$

When pipe or tube walls are thin and of high-conductivity material (as in typical heating and cooling coils), the term $(D_o - D_i)/2000k$ in Equation (5a) frequently becomes negligible and is generally disregarded. (This effect in typical bare-pipe cooling coils seldom exceeds 1 to 2% of the overall coefficient.) Thus, the overall coefficient for bare pipe in its simplest form is

$$U_o = \frac{1}{(1/f_a) + (B/f_r)} \quad (5b)$$

For finned coils, the equation for the overall coefficient of heat transfer can be written

$$U_o = \frac{1}{(1/\eta f_a) + (B/f_r)} \quad (5c)$$

where the **fin effectiveness** η allows for the resistance to heat flow encountered in the fins. It is defined as

$$\eta = (EA_s + A_p)/A_o \quad (6)$$

For typical cooling surface designs, the surface ratio B ranges from about 1.03 to 1.15 for bare-pipe coils and from 10 to 30 for finned coils. Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describes how to estimate fin efficiency and calculate the tube-side heat transfer coefficient f_r for nonvolatile fluids. Table 3 in AHRI *Standard* 410 lists thermal conductivity k of standard coil materials.

Estimating the air-side heat transfer coefficient f_a is more difficult because well-verified general predictive techniques are not available. Hence, direct use of experimental data is usually necessary. For plate fin coils, some correlations that satisfy several data sets are available (Kusuda 1970; McQuiston 1981). Webb (1980) reviewed air-side heat transfer and pressure drop correlations for various geometries. Mueller (1973) and Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* provide guidance on this subject.

For analyzing a given heat exchanger, the concept of **effectiveness** is useful. Expressions for effectiveness have been derived for various flow configurations and can be found in Kusuda (1970) and Mueller (1973). The cooling coils covered in this chapter actually involve various forms of cross-flow. However, the case of counterflow is addressed here to illustrate the value of this concept. The air-side effectiveness E_a for counterflow heat exchangers is given by the following equations:

$$q_{td} = 1000 w_a c_p (t_{a1} - t_{r1}) E_a \quad (7a)$$

with

$$E_a = \frac{t_{a1} - t_{a2}}{t_{a1} - t_{r1}} \quad (7b)$$

or

$$E_a = \frac{1 - e^{-c_o(1-M)}}{1 - Me^{-c_o(1-M)}} \quad (7c)$$

with

$$c_o = \frac{A_o U_o}{1000 w_a c_p} = \frac{F_s N_r U_o}{1000 \rho_a V_a c_p} \quad (7d)$$

and

$$M = \frac{w_a c_p}{w_r c_r} = \frac{\rho_a A_a V_a c_p}{w_r c_r} \quad (7e)$$

Note the following two special conditions:

If $M = 0$, then $E_a = 1 - e^{-c_o}$

If $M \geq 1$, then

$$E_a = \frac{1}{(1/c_o) + 1}$$

With a given design and arrangement of heat transfer surface used as cooling coil core material for which basic physical and heat transfer data are available to determine U_o from Equations (5a), (5b), and (5c), the selection, sizing, and performance calculation of sensible cooling coils for a particular application generally fall into either of two categories:

1. Heat transfer surface area A_o or coil row depth N_r for a specific coil size is required and initially unknown. Sensible cooling capacity q_{td}, flow rates for both air and coolant, entrance and exit temperatures of both fluids, and mean temperature difference between fluids are initially known or can be assumed or determined from Equations (2a), (3), and (4). A_o or N_r can then be calculated directly from Equation (1a).
2. Sensible cooling capacity q_{td} for a specific coil is required and initially unknown. Face area and heat transfer surface area are known or can be readily determined. Flow rates and entering temperatures of air and coolant are also known. Mean temperature difference Δt_m is unknown, but its determination is unnecessary to calculate q_{td}, which can be found directly by solving Equation (7a). Equation (7a) also provides a basic means of determining q_{td} for a given coil or related family of coils over the complete rating ranges of air and coolant flow rates and operating temperatures.

The two categories of application problems are shown in Examples 1 and 2, respectively:

Example 1. Standard air flowing at a mass rate equivalent to 4.2 m³/s is to be cooled from 29.5 to 24°C, using 2.5 kg/s chilled water supplied at 10°C in thermal counterflow arrangement. Assuming an air face velocity of V_a = 3 m/s and no air dehumidification, calculate coil face area A_a, sensible cooling capacity q_{td}, required heat transfer surface area A_o, coil row depth N_r, and coil air-side pressure drop Δp_{st} for a clean, nonfouled, thin-walled bare copper tube surface design for which the following physical and performance data have been predetermined:

B = surface ratio = 1.07
c_p = 1.0 kJ/(kg·K)
c_r = 4.18 kJ/(kg·K)
F_s = (external surface area)/(face area)(rows deep) = 1.34
f_a = 85 W/(m²·K)
f_r = 4500 W/(m²·K)
$\Delta p_{st}/N_r$ = 6.7 Pa/number of coil rows
ρ_a = 1.20 kg/m³

Solution: Calculate the coil face area required.

$$A_a = 4.2/\!/ = 1.4 \text{ m}^2$$

Neglecting the effect of tube wall, from Equation (5b),

$$U_o = \frac{1}{(1/85) + (1.07/4500)} = 83.3 \text{ W/(m}^2\cdot\text{K)}$$

From Equations (2a) and (2b), the sensible cooling capacity is

$$q_{td} = 1000 \times 1.20 \times 1.4 \times 3 \times 1.0(29.5 - 24) = 27\,700 \text{ W}$$

From Equation (3),

$$t_{r2} = 10 + 27\,700/(1000 \times 2.5 \times 4.18) = 12.7°\text{C}$$

From Equation (4),

$$\Delta\Delta t_m = \frac{(29.5 - 12.7) - (24 - 10)}{\ln[(29.5 - 12.7)/(24 - 10)]} = 15.4°C$$

From Equations (1a) and (1b), the surface area required is

$$A_o = 27\,700/(83.3 \times 15.4) = 21.6 \text{ m}^2 \text{ external surface}$$

From Equation (1b), the required row depth is

$$N_r = 21.6/(1.34 \times 1.4) = 11.5 \text{ rows deep}$$

The installed 1.4 m^2 coil face, 12 rows deep, slightly exceeds the required capacity. The air-side pressure drop for the installed row depth is then

$$\Delta\Delta\Delta p_{st} = (\Delta p_{st}/N_r)N_r = 6.7 \times 12 = 80 \text{ Pa at } 20°C$$

In this example, for some applications where such items as V_a, w_r, t_{r1}, and f_r may be arbitrarily varied with a fixed design and arrangement of heat transfer surface, a trade-off between coil face area A_a and coil row depth N_r is sometimes made to obtain alternative coil selections that produce the same sensible cooling capacity q_{td}. For example, an eight-row coil could be selected, but it would require a larger face area A_a with lower air face velocity V_a and a lower air-side pressure drop Δp_{st}.

Example 2. An air-cooling coil using a finned tube-type heat transfer surface has physical data as follows:

A_a = 1.0 m^2
A_o = 75 m^2 external
B = surface ratio = 20
F_s = (external surface area)/(face area)(rows deep) = 27
N_r = 3 rows deep

Air at a face velocity of V_a = 4 m/s and 35°C entering air temperature is to be cooled by 1.0 L/s of well water supplied at 13°C. Calculate the sensible cooling capacity q_{td}, leaving-air temperature t_{a2}, leaving-water temperature t_{r2}, and air-side pressure drop Δp_{st}. Assume clean and nonfouled surfaces, thermal counterflow between air and water, no air dehumidification, standard barometric air pressure, and that the following data are available or can be predetermined:

c_p = 1.0 kJ/(kg·K)
c_r = 4.18 kJ/(kg·K)
f_a = 97 W/(m^2·K)
f_r = 2800 W/(m^2·K)
η = fin effectiveness = 0.9
$\Delta p_{st}/N_r$ = 55 Pa/number of coil rows
ρ_a = 1.20 kg/m^3
ρ_w = 998 kg/m^3

Solution: From Equation (5c),

$$U_o = \frac{1}{1/(0.9 \times 97) + (20/2800)} = 54 \text{ W/(m}^2\cdot\text{K)}$$

From Equations (7d) and (2b),

$$c_o = \frac{75 \times 54}{1000 \times 1.20 \times 1.0 \times 4 \times 1.0} = 0.84$$

From Equation (7e),

$$M = \frac{1.20 \times 1.0 \times 4 \times 1.0}{1.0 \times 0.998 \times 4.18} = 1.15$$

Substituting in,

$$-c_o(1 - M) = -0.84(1 - 1.15) = 0.125$$

From Equation (7c),

$$E_a = \frac{1 - e^{0.126}}{1 - 1.15e^{0.126}} = 0{,}441$$

From Equation (7a), the sensible cooling capacity is

$$q_{td} = 1000 \times 1.20 \times 1.0 \times 4 \times 1.0(35 - 13) \times 0.441 = 46\,600 \text{ W}$$

From Equation (2a), the leaving-air temperature is

$$t_{a2} = 35 - \frac{46\,600}{1000 \times 1.20 \times 1.0 \times 4 \times 1.0} = 25.3°C$$

From Equation (3), the leaving-water temperature is

$$t_{r2} = 13 + \frac{46\,600}{1000 \times 1.0 \times 0.998 \times 4.18} = 24.2°C$$

The air-side pressure drop is

$$\Delta p_{st} = 55 \times 3 = 165 \text{ Pa}$$

The preceding equations and examples demonstrate the method for calculating thermal performance of sensible cooling coils that operate with a dry surface. However, when cooling coils operate wet or act as dehumidifying coils, performance cannot be predicted without including the effect of air-side moisture (latent heat) removal.

7. PERFORMANCE OF DEHUMIDIFYING COILS

A dehumidifying coil normally removes both moisture and sensible heat from entering air. In most air-conditioning processes, the air to be cooled is a mixture of water vapor and dry air gases. Both lose sensible heat when in contact with a surface cooler than the air. Latent heat is removed through condensation only on the parts of the coil where the surface temperature is lower than the dew point of the air passing over it. Figure 2 in Chapter 4 shows the assumed psychrometric conditions of this process. As the leaving dry-bulb temperature drops below the entering dew-point temperature, the difference between leaving dry-bulb temperature and leaving dew point for a given coil, airflow, and entering air condition is lessened.

When the coil starts to remove moisture, the cooling surfaces carry both the sensible and latent heat load. As the air approaches saturation, each degree of sensible cooling is nearly matched by a corresponding degree of dew-point decrease. The latent heat removal per degree of dew-point change is considerably greater. The following table compares the amount of moisture removed from air at standard barometric pressure that is cooled from 16 to 15°C at both wet and dry conditions.

Dew Point	h_s, kJ/kg	Dry Bulb	h_{da}, kJ/kg
16°C	44.966	16°C	16.093
15°C	42.115	15°C	15.087
Difference	2.850	Difference	1.006

Note: These numerical values conform to Table 2 in Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

For volatile refrigerant coils, the refrigerant distributor assembly must be tested at the higher and lower capacities of its rated range. Testing at lower capacities checks whether the refrigerant distributor provides equal distribution and whether the control is able to modulate without hunting. Testing at higher capacities checks the maximum feeding capacity of the flow control device at the greater pressure drop that occurs in the coil system.

Most manufacturers develop and produce their own performance rating tables using data obtained from suitable tests. ASHRAE *Standard* 33 specifies the acceptable method of lab-testing coils. AHRI *Standard* 410 gives a method for rating thermal performance of dehumidifying coils by extending data from laboratory tests on prototypes to other operating conditions, coil sizes, and row depths. To account for simultaneous transfer of both sensible and latent heat from the airstream to the surface, AHRI *Standard* 410 uses essentially the same method for arriving at cooling and dehumidifying coil thermal performance as determined by McElgin and Wiley (1940) and described in the context of *Standard* 410 by Anderson (1970). In systems operating at partial flow such as in thermal storage, accurate performance predictions for 2300 < Re < 4000 flows have been obtained by using the Gnielinski correlation. This work was presented in detail comparable to *Standard* 410 by Mirth et al. (1993).

The potential or driving force for transferring total heat q_t from the airstream to the tube-side coolant is composed of two compo-

nents in series heat flow: (1) an air-to-surface air enthalpy difference ($h_a - h_s$) and (2) a surface-to-coolant temperature difference ($t_s - t_r$).

Figure 7 is a typical thermal diagram for a coil in which the air and a nonvolatile coolant are arranged in counterflow. The top and bottom lines in the diagram indicate, respectively, changes across the coil in the airstream enthalpy h_a and the coolant temperature t_r. To illustrate continuity, the single middle line in Figure 7 represents both surface temperature t_s and the corresponding saturated air enthalpy h_s, although the temperature and air enthalpy scales do not actually coincide as shown. The differential surface area dA_w represents any specific location within the coil thermal diagram where operating conditions are such that the air-surface interface temperature t_s is lower than the local air dew-point temperature. Under these conditions, both sensible and latent heat are removed from the airstream, and the cooler surface actively condenses water vapor.

Neglecting the enthalpy of condensed water vapor leaving the surface and any radiation and convection losses, the total heat lost from the airstream in flowing over dA_w is

$$dq_t = -w_a(dh_a) \tag{8}$$

This same total heat is transferred from the airstream to the surface interface. According to McElgin and Wiley (1940),

$$dq_t = \frac{(h_a - h_s)dA_w}{c_p R_{aw}} \tag{9}$$

The total heat transferred from the air-surface interface across the surface elements and into the coolant is equal to that given in Equations (8) and (9):

$$dq_t = \frac{(t_s - t_r)dA_w}{R_{mw} + R_r} \tag{10}$$

The same quantity of total heat is also gained by the nonvolatile coolant in passing across dA_w:

$$dq_t = -w_r c_r (dt_r) \tag{11}$$

If Equations (9) and (10) are equated and the terms rearranged, an expression for the coil characteristic C is obtained:

$$C = \frac{R_{mw} + R_r}{c_p R_{aw}} = \frac{t_s - t_r}{h_a - h_s} \tag{12}$$

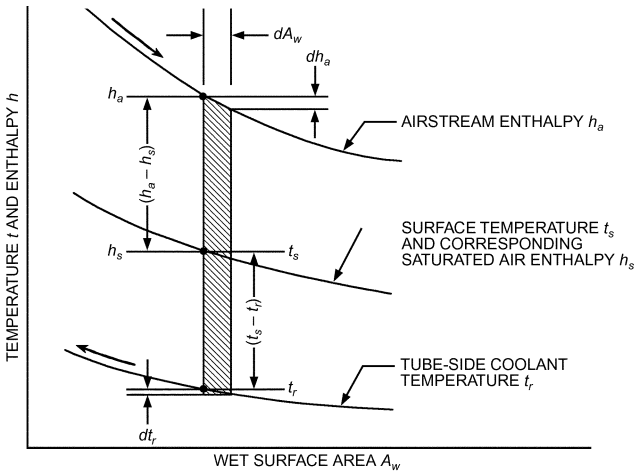

Fig. 7 Two-Component Driving Force Between Dehumidifying Air and Coolant

Equation (12) shows the basic relationship of the two components of the driving force between air and coolant in terms of three principal thermal resistances. For a given coil, these three resistances of air, metal, and in-tube fluid (R_{aw}, R_{mw}, and R_r) are usually known or can be determined for the particular application, which gives a fixed value for C. Equation (12) can then be used to determine point conditions for the interrelated values of airstream enthalpy h_a, coolant temperature t_r, surface temperature t_s, and enthalpy h_s of saturated air corresponding to the surface temperature. When both t_s and h_s are unknown, a trial-and-error solution is necessary; however, this can be solved graphically by a surface temperature chart such as Figure 8.

Figure 9 shows a typical thermal diagram for a portion of the coil surface when it is operating dry. The illustration is for counterflow with a halocarbon refrigerant. The diagram at the top of the figure shows a typical coil installation in an air duct with tube passes circuited countercurrent to airflow. Locations of the entering and leaving boundary conditions for both air and coolant are shown.

The thermal diagram in Figure 9 is the same type as in Figure 7, showing three lines to illustrate local conditions for the air, surface, and coolant throughout a coil. The dry/wet boundary conditions are

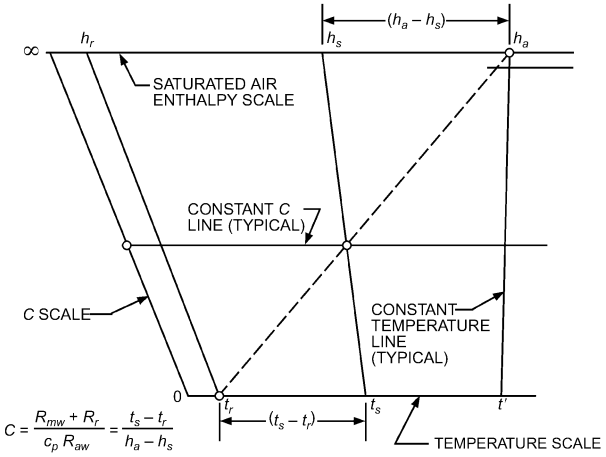

Fig. 8 Surface Temperature Chart

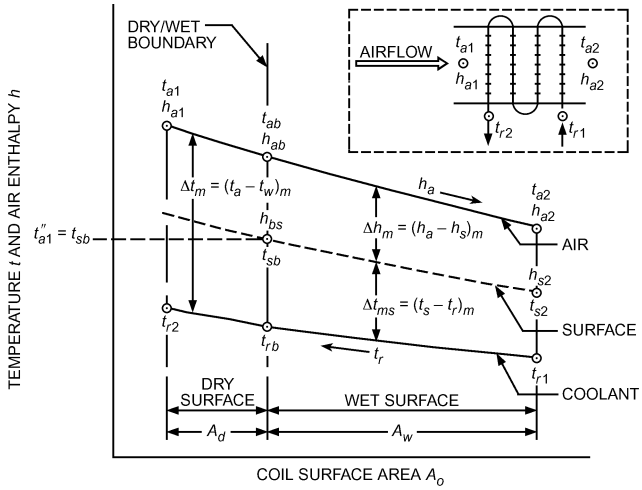

Fig. 9 Thermal Diagram for General Case When Coil Surface Operates Partially Dry

located where the coil surface temperature t_{sb} equals the entering air dew-point temperature t''_{a1}. Thus, the surface area A_d to the left of this boundary is dry, with the remainder A_w of the coil surface area operating wet.

When using fluids or halocarbon refrigerants in a thermal counterflow arrangement as shown in Figure 9, the dry/wet boundary conditions can be determined from the following relationships:

$$y = \frac{t_{r2} - t_{r1}}{h_{a1} - h_{a2}} = \frac{w_a}{w_r c_r} \tag{13}$$

$$h_{ab} = \frac{t''_{a1} - t_{r2} + y h_{a1} + C h''_{a1}}{C + y} \tag{14}$$

The value of h_{ab} from Equation (14) serves as an index of whether the coil surface is operating fully wetted, partially dry, or completely dry, according to the following three limits:

1. If $h_{ab} \geq h_{a1}$, the surface is fully wetted.
2. If $h_{a1} > h_{ab} > h_{a2}$, the surface is partially dry.
3. If $h_{ab} \leq h_{a2}$, the surface is completely dry.

Other dry/wet boundary properties are then determined:

$$t_{sb} = t''_{a1} \tag{15}$$

$$t_{ab} = t_{a1} - (h_{a1} - h_{ab})/c_p \tag{16}$$

$$t_{rb} = t_{r2} - y c_p (t_{a1} - t_{ab}) \tag{17}$$

The dry surface area A_d required and capacity q_{td} are calculated by conventional sensible heat transfer relationships, as follows.

The overall thermal resistance R_o comprises three basic elements:

$$R_o = R_{ad} + R_{md} + R_r \tag{18}$$

with

$$R_r = B/f_r \tag{19}$$

The mean difference between air dry-bulb temperature and coolant temperature, using symbols from Figure 9, is

$$\Delta t_m = \frac{(t_{a1} - t_{r2}) - (t_{ab} - t_{rb})}{\ln[(t_{a1} - t_{r2})/(t_{ab} - t_{rb})]} \tag{20}$$

The dry surface area required is

$$A_d = \frac{q_{td} R_o}{\Delta t_m} \tag{21}$$

The air-side total heat capacity is

$$q_{td} = 1000 w_a c_p (t_{a1} - t_{ab}) \tag{22a}$$

From the coolant side,

$$q_{td} = 1000 w_r c_r (t_{r2} - t_{rb}) \tag{22b}$$

The wet surface area A_w and capacity q_{tw} are determined by the following relationships, using terminology in Figure 9.

For a given coil size, design, and arrangement, the fixed value of the coil characteristic C can be determined from the ratio of the three prime thermal resistances for the job conditions:

$$C = \frac{R_{mw} + R_r}{c_p R_{aw}} \tag{23}$$

Knowing coil characteristic C for point conditions, the interrelations between airstream enthalpy h_a, coolant temperature t_r, and surface temperature t_s and its corresponding enthalpy of saturated air h_s can be determined by using a surface temperature chart (Figure 8) or by a trial-and-error procedure using Equation (24):

$$C = \frac{t_{sb} - t_{rb}}{h_{ab} - h_{sb}} = \frac{t_{s2} - t_{r1}}{h_{a2} - h_{s2}} \tag{24}$$

The mean effective difference in air enthalpy between airstream and surface from Figure 9 is

$$\Delta h_m = \frac{(h_{ab} - h_{sb}) - (h_{a2} - h_{s2})}{\ln[(h_{ab} - h_{sb})/(h_{a2} - h_{s2})]} \tag{25}$$

Similarly, the mean temperature difference between surface and coolant is

$$\Delta t_{ms} = \frac{(t_{sb} - t_{rb}) - (t_{s2} - t_{r1})}{\ln[(t_{sb} - t_{rb})/(t_{s2} - t_{r1})]} \tag{26}$$

The wet surface area required, calculated from air-side enthalpy difference, is

$$A_w = \frac{q_{tw} R_{aw} c_p}{\Delta h_m} \tag{27a}$$

Calculated from the coolant-side temperature difference,

$$A_w = \frac{q_{tw}(R_{mw} + R_r)}{\Delta t_{ms}} \tag{27b}$$

The air-side total heat capacity is

$$q_{tw} = 1000 w_a [h_{a1} - (h_{a2} + h_{fw})] \tag{28a}$$

The enthalpy h_{fw} of condensate removed is

$$h_{fw} = (W_1 - W_2) c_{pw} (t'_{a2} - 0) \tag{28b}$$

where c_{pw} = specific heat of water = 4.18 kJ/(kg·K).

Note that h_{fw} for normal air-conditioning applications is about 0.5% of the airstream enthalpy difference $(h_{a1} - h_{a2})$ and is usually neglected.

The coolant-side heat capacity is

$$q_{tw} = 1000 w_r c_r (t_{rb} - t_{r1}) \tag{28c}$$

The total surface area requirement of the coil is

$$A_o = A_d + A_w \tag{29}$$

The total heat capacity for the coil is

$$q_t = q_{td} + q_{tw} \tag{30}$$

The leaving-air dry-bulb temperature is found by the method shown in Figure 10, which represents part of a psychrometric chart showing the air saturation curve and lines of constant air enthalpy closely corresponding to constant-wet-bulb temperature lines.

For a given coil and air quantity, a straight line projected through the entering and leaving-air conditions intersects the air saturation curve at a point denoted as the effective coil surface temperature $t_{\bar{s}}$. Thus, for fixed entering air conditions t_{a1} and h_{a1} and a given effective surface temperature t_s, leaving air dry bulb t_{a2} increases but is still located on this straight line if air quantity is increased or coil depth is reduced. Conversely, a decrease in air quantity or an increase in coil depth produces a lower t_{a2} that is still located on the same straight-line segment.

An index of the air-side effectiveness is the heat transfer exponent c, defined as

$$c = \frac{A_o}{1000 w_a c_p R_{ad}} \tag{31}$$

This exponent c, sometimes called the number of air-side transfer units NTU_a, is also defined as

$$c = \frac{t_{a1} - t_{a2}}{\Delta t_{\bar{m}}} \tag{32}$$

The temperature drop $(t_{a1} - t_{a2})$ of the airstream and mean temperature difference $\Delta t_{\bar{m}}$ between air and effective surface in Equation (32) are shown at the top of Figure 10.

Knowing the exponent c and entering and leaving enthalpies h_{a1} and h_{a2} for the airstream, the enthalpy of saturated air $h_{\bar{s}}$ corresponding to effective surface temperature $t_{\bar{s}}$ is calculated as follows:

$$h_{\bar{s}} = h_{a1} - \frac{h_{a1} - h_{a2}}{1 - e^{-c}} \tag{33}$$

After finding the value of $t_{\bar{s}}$ that corresponds to $h_{\bar{s}}$ from the saturated air enthalpy tables, the leaving-air dry-bulb temperature can be determined:

$$t_{a2} = t_{\bar{s}} + e^{-c}(t_{a1} - t_{\bar{s}}) \tag{34}$$

The air-side sensible heat ratio SHR can then be calculated:

$$\text{SHR} = \frac{c_p(t_{a1} - t_{a2})}{h_{a1} - h_{a2}} \tag{35}$$

For thermal performance of a coil to be determined from the foregoing relationships, values of the following three principal resistances to heat flow between air and coolant must be known:

- Total metal thermal resistances across the fin R_f and tube assembly R_t for both dry R_{md} and wet R_{mw} surface operation
- Air-film thermal resistances R_{ad} and R_{aw} for dry and wet surfaces, respectively
- Tube-side coolant film thermal resistance R_r

In AHRI *Standard* 410, metal thermal resistance R_m is calculated based on the physical data, material, and arrangement of the fin and tube elements, together with the fin efficiency E for the specific fin configuration. R_m is variable as a weak function of the effective air-side heat transfer coefficient f_a for a specific coil geometry, as shown in Figure 11.

For wetted-surface application, Brown (1954), with certain simplifying assumptions, showed that f_a is directly proportional to the rate of change m'' of saturated air enthalpy h_s with the corresponding surface temperature t_s. This slope m'' of the air enthalpy saturation curve is shown in the small inset graph at the top of Figure 11.

The abscissa for f_a in the main graph of Figure 11 is an effective value, which, for a dry surface, is the simple thermal resistance reciprocal $1/R_{ad}$. For a wet surface, f_a is the product of the thermal resistance reciprocal $1/R_{aw}$ and the multiplying factor m''/c_p. AHRI *Standard* 410 outlines a method for obtaining a mean value of m''/c_p for a given coil and job condition. The total metal resistance R_m in Figure 11 includes the resistance R_t across the tube wall. For most coil designs, R_t is quite small compared to the resistance R_f through the fin metal.

The air-side thermal resistances R_{ad} and R_{aw} for dry and wet surfaces, together with their respective air-side pressure drops $\Delta p_{st}/N_r$ and $\Delta p_{sw}/N_r$, are determined from tests on a representative coil model over the full range in the rated airflow. Typical plots of experimental data for these four performance variables versus coil air face velocity V_a at 20°C are shown in Figure 12.

If water is used as the tube-side coolant, the heat transfer coefficient f_r is calculated from Equation (8) in AHRI *Standard* 410. For evaporating refrigerants, many predictive techniques for calculating coefficients of evaporation are listed in Table 2 in Chapter 5 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. The most verified predictive technique is the Shah correlation (Shah 1976, 1982). A series of tests is specified in AHRI *Standard* 410 for obtaining heat transfer data for direct-expansion refrigerants inside tubes of a given diameter.

ASHRAE *Standard* 33 specifies laboratory apparatus and instrumentation, including procedure and operating criteria for conducting tests on representative coil prototypes to obtain basic performance data. Procedures are available in AHRI *Standard* 410 for reducing these test data to the performance parameters necessary to rate a line or lines of various air coils. This information is available from various coil manufacturers for use in selecting AHRI *Standard* 410 certified coils.

The following example shows a method for selecting coil size, row depth, and performance data to satisfy specified job requirements. The application is for typical cooling and dehumidifying coil selection under conditions in which a part of the coil surface on the enter-

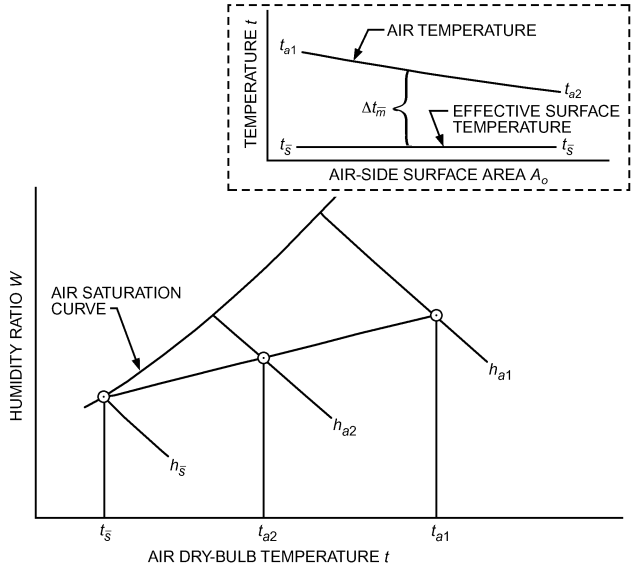

Fig. 10 Leaving-Air Dry-Bulb Temperature Determination for Air-Cooling and Dehumidifying Coils

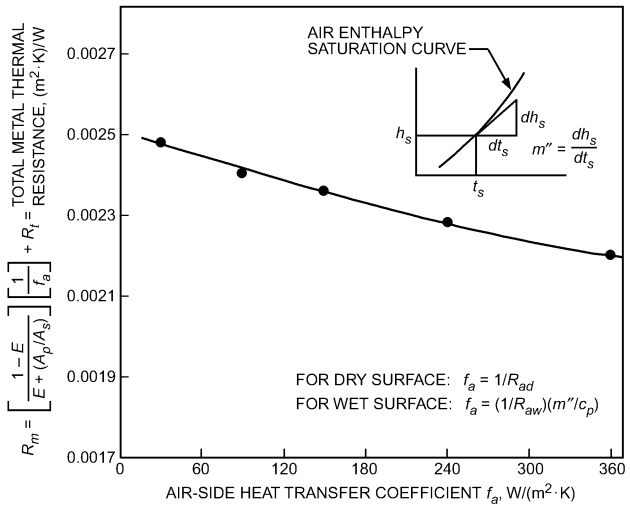

Fig. 11 Typical Total Metal Thermal Resistance of Fin and Tube Assembly

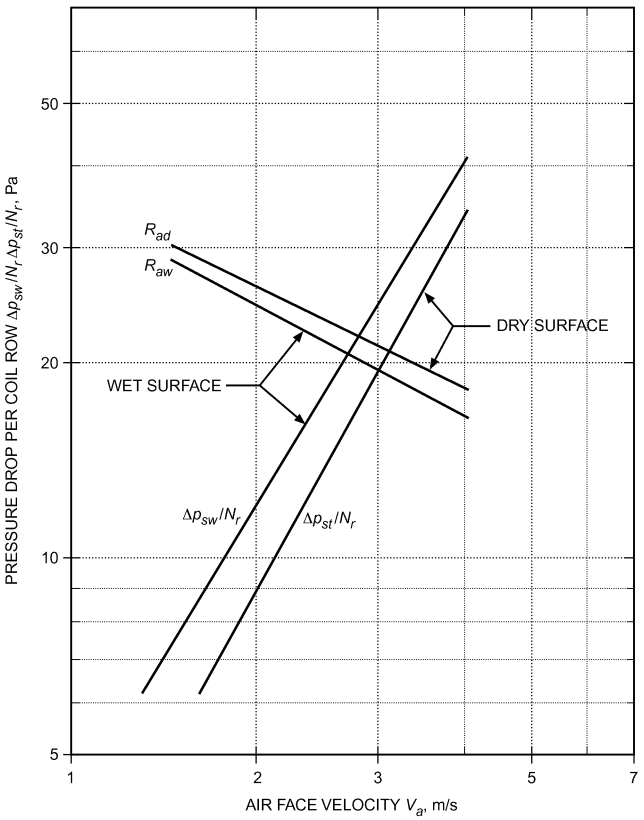

Fig. 12 Typical Air-Side Application Rating Data Determined Experimentally for Cooling and Dehumidifying Water Coils

ing air side operates dry, with the remaining surface wet with condensing moisture. Figure 9 shows the thermal diagram, dry/wet boundary conditions, and terminology used in the problem solution.

Example 3. Standard air flowing at a mass rate equivalent of 3.2 m³/s enters a coil at 27°C db (t_{a1}) and 19.5°C wb (t'_{a1}). The air is to be cooled to 13.5°C leaving wet-bulb temperature t'_{a2} using 2.5 L/s of chilled water supplied to the coil at an entering temperature t_{r1} of 6.5°C, in thermal counterflow arrangement. Assume a standard coil air face velocity of V_a = 2.8 m/s and a clean, nonfouled, finned-tube heat transfer surface in the coil core, for which the following physical and performance data (such as shown in Figures 11 and 12) can be predetermined:

B = surface ratio = 25.9
c_p = 1.00 kJ/(kg·K)
F_s = (external surface area)/(face area)(row deep) = 31.2
f_r = 4260 W/(m²·K)
$\Delta p_{sd}/N_r$ = 40 Pa/number of coil rows, dry surface
$\Delta p_{sw}/N_r$ = 65 Pa/number of coil rows, wet surface
R_{ad} = 0.013 (m²·K)/W
R_{aw} = 0.012 (m²·K)/W
R_{md} = 0.004 (m²·K)/W
R_{mw} = 0.003 (m²·K)/W
ρ_a = 1.20 kg/m³
ρ_w = 998 kg/m³

Referring to Figure 9 for the symbols and typical diagram for applications in which only a part of the coil surface operates wet, determine (1) coil face area A_a, (2) total refrigeration load q_t, (3) leaving coolant temperature t_{r2}, (4) dry/wet boundary conditions, (5) heat transfer surface area required for dry A_d and wet A_w sections of the coil core, (6) leaving-air dry-bulb temperature t_{a2}, (7) total number N_{ri} of installed coil rows, and (8) dry Δp_{st} and wet Δp_{sw} coil air friction.

Solution: The psychrometric properties and enthalpies for dry and moist air are based on Figure 1 (ASHRAE Psychrometric Chart No. 1) and Tables 2 and 3 in Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* as follows:

h_{a1} = 55.6 kJ/kg h''_{a1} = 43.81 kJ/kg
W_1 = 11.2 g/kg $*h_{a2}$ = 37.93 kJ/kg
t''_{a1} = 15.6°C $*W_2$ = 9.7 g/kg

*As an approximation, assume leaving air is saturated (i.e., $t_{a2} = t'_{a2}$).

Calculate coil face area required:

$$A_a = 3.2/2.8 + 1.14 \text{ m}^2$$

From Equation (28b), find condensate heat rejection:

$$h_{fw} = (11.2 - 9.7)(4.18)(13.5)/1000 = 0.085 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

Compute the total refrigeration load from the following equation:

$$q_t = \rho_a w_a[h_{a1} - (h_{a2} + h_{fw})] = 1.20 \times 3.2[55.6 - (37.93 + 0.085)] = 67.6 \text{ kW}$$

From Equation (3), calculate coolant temperature leaving coil:

$$t_{r2} = t_{r1} + q_t / w_r c_r = 6.5 + 67.6/(2.5 \times 0.998 \times 4.18) = 13.0°\text{C}$$

From Equation (19), determine coolant film thermal resistance:

$$R_r = 25.9/4260 = 0.006(\text{m}^2 \cdot \text{K})/\text{W}$$

Calculate the wet coil characteristic from Equation (23):

$$C = \frac{0.003 + 0.006}{1.00 \times 0.012} = 0.75(\text{kg} \cdot \text{K})/\text{kJ}$$

Calculate from Equation (13):

$$y = \frac{13.0 - 6.5}{55.6 - 37.93} = 0.371(\text{kg} \cdot \text{K})/\text{kJ}$$

The dry/wet boundary conditions are determined as follows:
From Equation (14), the boundary airstream enthalpy is

$$h_{ab} = \frac{(15.7 - 13) + (0.367 \times 55.6) + (0.75 \times 43.81)}{0.75 + 0.371} = 48.93 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

According to limit (2) under Equation (14), part of the coil surface on the entering air side will be operating dry, because $h_{a1} > 50.5 > h_{a2}$ (see Figure 8).

From Equation (16), the boundary airstream dry-bulb temperature is

$$t_{ab} = 27 - (55.6 - 49.93)/1.00 = 21.33°\text{C}$$

The boundary surface conditions are

$$t_{sb} = t''_{a1} = 15.7°\text{C} \quad \text{and} \quad h_{sb} = h''_{a1} = 43.98 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

From Equation (17), the boundary coolant temperature is

$$t_{rb} = 13.0 - 0.367 \times 1.00(27 - 21.8) = 10.92°\text{C}$$

The cooling load for the dry surface part of the coil is now calculated from Equation (22b):

$$q_{td} = 2.5 \times 0.998 \times 4.18(13.0 - 10.92) = 19.8 \text{ kW}$$

From Equation (18), the overall thermal resistance for the dry surface section is

$$R_o = 0.013 + 0.004 + 0.006 = 0.023 \text{ (m}^2 \cdot \text{K)/W}$$

From Equation (20), the mean temperature difference between air dry bulb and coolant for the dry surface section is

$$\Delta t_m = \frac{(27 - 13.0) - (21.33 - 10.92)}{\ln[(27 - 13.0)/(21.33 - 10.92)]} = 12.12 \text{ K}$$

The dry surface area required is calculated from Equation (21):

$$A_d = 19.8 \times 0.023 \times 1000/12.12 = 37.6 \text{ m}^2$$

From Equation (30), the cooling load for the wet surface section of the coil is

$$q_{tw} = 67.6 - 19.8 = 47.8 \text{ kW}$$

Knowing C, h_{a2}, and t_{r1}, the surface condition at the leaving-air side of the coil is calculated by trial and error using Equation (24):

$$C = 0.75 = (t_{s2} - 6.5)/(38.0 - h_{s2})$$

The numerical values for t_{s2} and h_{s2} are then determined directly by using a surface temperature chart (as shown in Figure 8 or in Figure 9 of AHRI *Standard* 410) and saturated air enthalpies from Table 2 in Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*:

$$t_{s2} = 10.8°\text{C} \quad \text{and} \quad h_{s2} = 31.16 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

From Equation (25), the mean effective difference in air enthalpy between airstream and surface is

$$\Delta h_m = \frac{(49.93 - 43.81) - (37.93 - 31.16)}{\ln[(49.93 - 43.81)/(37.93 - 31.16)]} = 6.44 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

From Equation (27a), the wet surface area required is

$$A_w = 47.8 \times 1000 \times 0.012 \times 1.00/6.44 = 89 \text{ m}^2$$

From Equation (29), the net total surface area requirement for the coil is then

$$A_o = 37.6 + 89 = 126.6 \text{ m}^2 \text{ external}$$

From Equation (31), the net air-side heat transfer exponent is

$$c = 126.6/(1000 \times 1.20 \times 1.14 \times 2.8 \times 1.00 \times 0.013) = 2.54$$

From Equation (33), the enthalpy of saturated air corresponding to the effective surface temperature is

$$h_{\bar{s}} = 55.6 - \frac{55.6 - 38.0}{1 - e^{-2.54}} = 36.4 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

The effective surface temperature that corresponds to $h_{\bar{s}}$ is then obtained from Table 2 in Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* as $t_{\bar{s}} = 13.0°\text{C}$.

The leaving-air dry-bulb temperature is calculated from Equation (34):

$$t_{a2} = 13.0 + e^{-2.54}(27 - 13.0) = 14.1°\text{C}$$

The air-side sensible heat ratio is then found from Equation (35):

$$\text{SHR} = \frac{1.00(27 - 14.1)}{55.6 - 37.9} = 0.729$$

From Equation (1b), the calculated coil row depth N_{rc} to match job requirements is

$$N_{rc} = A_o/A_a F_s = 135/(1.14 \times 31.2) = 3.80 \text{ rows deep}$$

In most coil selection problems of this type, the initial calculated row depth to satisfy job requirements is usually a noninteger value. In many cases, there is sufficient flexibility in fluid flow rates and operating temperature levels to recalculate the required row depth of a given coil size to match an available integer row depth more closely. For this example, if the calculated row depth is $N_{rc} = 3.8$, and coils of three or four rows deep are commercially available, the coil face area, operating conditions, and fluid flow rates and/or velocities could possibly be changed to recalculate a coil depth close to either three or four rows. Although core tube circuitry has limited possibilities on odd (e.g., three or five) row coils, alternative coil selections for the same job are often made desirable by trading off coil face size for row depth.

Most coil manufacturers have computer programs to run the iterations needed to predict operating values for specific coil performance requirements. The next highest integral row depth than computed is then selected for a commercially available coil with an even number of circuits, same end connected. For this example, assume that the initial coil selection requiring 3.8 rows deep is sufficiently refined that no recalculation is necessary, and that a 4-row coil with 4-pass coil circuitry is available. Thus, the installed row depth N_{ri} is

$$N_{ri} = 4 \text{ rows deep}$$

The amount of heat transfer surface area installed is

$$A_{oi} = A_a F_s N_{ri} = 1.14 \times 31.2 \times 4 = 142 \text{ m}^2 \text{ external}$$

The completely dry and completely wetted air-side frictions are, respectively,

$$\Delta p_{sd} = (A_d/A_o)(\Delta p_{sd}/N_{ri})N_{ri} = (37/135) \times 40 \times 4 = 44 \text{ Pa}$$

and

$$\Delta p_{sw} = (A_w/A_o)(\Delta p_{sw}/N_{ri})N_{ri} = (98/135) \times 65 \times 4 = 189 \text{ Pa}$$

$$\Delta p_{st} = (A_{oi}/A_o)\Delta p_{sd} + \Delta p_{sw} = (142/135) \times (44 + 189) = 245 \text{ Pa total}$$

A more realistic Δp estimate of a coil operating at >70% wetted surface and a velocity > 2 m/s would be to consider the entire surface as wetted. Therefore, 65 × 4 = 260 Pa would be the coil's operating air-side static pressure.

In summary,

A_a = 1.14 m^2 coil face area
N_{ri} = 4 rows installed coil depth
A_{oi} = 142 m^2 installed heat transfer surface area
A_o = 135 m^2 required heat transfer surface area
q_t = 67.6 kW total refrigeration load
t_{r2} = 13.0°C leaving coolant temperature
t_{a2} = 13.9°C leaving-air dry-bulb temperature
SHR = 0.740 air sensible heat ratio
Δp_{sw} = 189 Pa wet-coil surface air friction
Δp_{sd} = 44 Pa dry-coil surface air friction
Δp_{st} = 245 Pa total coil surface air friction

8. DETERMINING REFRIGERATION LOAD

The following calculation of refrigeration load distinguishes between the true sensible and latent heat loss of the air, which is accurate within the data's limitations. This division will not correspond to load determination obtained from approximate factors or constants.

The total refrigeration load q_t of a cooling and dehumidifying coil (or air washer) per unit mass of dry air is indicated in Figure 13 and consists of the following components:

- The sensible heat q_s removed from the dry air and moisture in cooling from entering temperature t_1 to leaving temperature t_2
- The latent heat q_e removed to condense the moisture at the dew-point temperature t_4 of the entering air

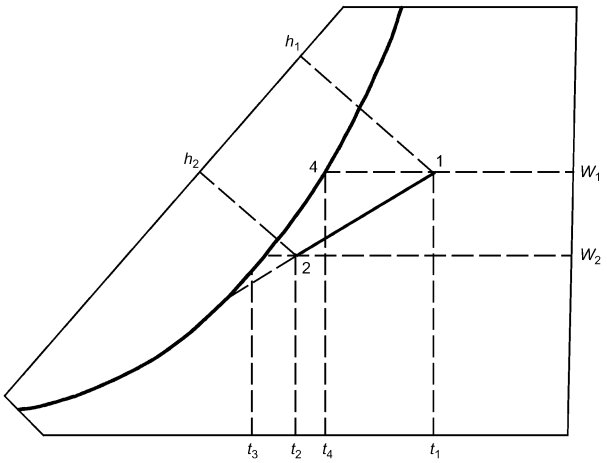

Fig. 13 Psychrometric Performance of Cooling and Dehumidifying Coil

- The heat q_w removed to further cool the condensate from its dew point t_4 to its leaving condensate temperature t_3

The preceding components are related by the following equation:

$$q_t = q_s + q_e + q_w \quad (36)$$

If only the total heat value is desired, it may be computed by

$$q_t = (h_1 - h_2) - (W_1 - W_2)h_{w3} \quad (37)$$

where

h_1 and h_2 = enthalpy of air at points 1 and 2, respectively
W_1 and W_2 = humidity ratio at points 1 and 2, respectively
h_{w3} = enthalpy of saturated liquid at final temperature t_3

If a breakdown into latent and sensible heat components is desired, the following relations may be used.

Latent heat may be found from

$$q_e = (W_1 - W_2)h_{fg4} \quad (38)$$

where

h_{fg4} = enthalpy representing latent heat of water vapor at condensing temperature t_4

Sensible heat may be shown to be

$$q_s + q_w = (h_1 - h_2) - (W_1 - W_2)h_{g4} + (W_1 - W_2)(h_{w4} - h_{w3}) \quad (39)$$

or

$$q_s + q_w = (h_1 - h_2) - (W_1 - W_2)(h_{fg4} + h_{w3}) \quad (39a)$$

where

$h_{g4} = h_{fg4} + h_{w4}$ = enthalpy of saturated water vapor at condensing temperature t_4
h_{w4} = enthalpy of saturated liquid at condensing temperature t_4

The last term in Equation (39a) is the heat of subcooling the condensate from t_4 to its final temperature t_3. Then,

$$q_w = (W_1 - W_2)(h_{w4} - h_{w3}) \quad (40)$$

The final condensate temperature t_3 leaving the system is subject to substantial variations, depending on the method of coil installation, as affected by coil face orientation, airflow direction, and air duct insulation. In practice, t_3 is frequently the same as the leaving wet-bulb temperature. Within the normal air-conditioning range, precise values of t_3 are not necessary because the heat q_t of condensate removed from the air usually represents about 0.5 to 1.5% of the total refrigeration cooling load.

Example 4. Air enters a coil at 32°C db, 24°C wb; it leaves at 16°C db, 14.5°C wb; leaving-water temperature is assumed to be 12°C, which is between the leaving-air dew-point and coil surface temperatures. Find the total, latent, and sensible cooling loads on the coil with air at standard barometric pressure.

Solution: Using Figure 1 (or the indicated equations) from Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*,

h_1 = 72.04 kJ/kg (dry air) (32)
h_2 = 40.69 kJ/kg (dry air) (32)
W_1 = 0.01557 kg (water)/kg (dry air) (35)
W_2 = 0.00972 kg (water)/kg (dry air) (35)
t_4 = 20.85°C dew point of entering air (39)
h_{w4} = 4.186 × 20.85 = 87.28 kJ/kg (34)
h_{w3} = 4.186 × 12.00 = 50.23 kJ/kg (34)
h_{g4} = 2501 + (1.805 × 20.85) = 2538.63 kJ/kg (31)
$h_{fg4} = h_{g4} - h_{w4}$ = 2451.35 kJ/kg (31)

From Equation (37), the total heat is

$$q_t = (72.04 - 40.69) - (0.01557 - 0.00972)50.23 = 31.06 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

From Equation (38), the latent heat is

$$q_e = (0.01557 - 0.00972)2451.35 = 14.34 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

The sensible heat is therefore

$$q_s + q_w = q_t - q_e = 31.06 - 14.34 = 16.72 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

The sensible heat may be computed from Equation (39a) as

$$q_s + q_w = (72.04 - 40.69) - (0.01557 - 0.00972)2538.63 + (0.01557 - 0.00972)(87.28 - 50.23) = 16.72 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

The same value is found using Equation (39b). The subcooling of the condensate as a part of the sensible heat is indicated by the last term of the equation, 0.19 kJ/kg.

9. MAINTENANCE

If the coil is to deliver its full cooling capacity, both its internal and external surfaces must be clean. The tubes generally stay clean in pressurized water or brine systems. Tube surfaces can be cleaned in a number of ways, but are often washed with low-pressure water spray and mild detergent. Water coils should be completely drained if freezing is possible. When coils use built-up system refrigerant evaporators, oil can accumulate. Check and drain oil occasionally, and check for leaks and refrigerant dryness.

Air Side. The best maintenance for the outside finned area is consistent inspection and service of inlet air filters. Surface cleaning of the coil with pressurized hot water and a mild detergent should be done only when necessary (primarily when a blockage occurs under severe fin-surface-fouling service conditions, or bacterial growth is seen or suspected). Pressurized cleaning is more thorough if done first from the air exit side of the coil and then from the air entry side. Foaming chemical sprays and washes should be used instead of high pressure on fragile fins, or when fin density is too restrictive to allow proper in-depth cleaning with pressurized water spray. In all cases, limit spray water temperature to below 65°C on evaporator coils containing refrigerant. In cases of marked neglect or heavy-duty use (especially in restaurants where grease and dirt have accumulated) coils must sometimes be removed and the accumulation washed off with steam, compressed air and water, or hot water.

The surfaces can also be brushed and vacuumed. Best practice is to inspect and service the filters frequently. Also, condensate drain pan(s) and their drain lines, including open drain areas, should be kept clean and clear at all times.

Water Side. The best service for the inside tube coil surface is keeping the circulated fluid (water or glycol) free of sediment, corrosive products, and biological growth. Maintaining proper circulated water chemistry and velocity and filtering out solids should minimize the water-side fouling factor. If large amounts of scale form when untreated water is used as coolant, chemical or mechanical (rod) cleaning of internal surfaces at frequent intervals is necessary. A properly maintained chilled-water system using a glycol solution as the circulated fluid is not considered to ever have water-side fouling, as such, but glycol solutions must be analyzed seasonally to determine alkalinity, percent concentration, and corrosion inhibitor condition. Consult a glycol expert or the manufacturer's agent for detailed recommendations on proper use and control of glycol solutions.

Refrigerant Side. Moisture content of the refrigerant should be checked yearly, and acidity of the compressor oil as often as monthly. For built-up direct-expansion (DX) systems, normal is ≤50 mg/kg of moisture for systems with mineral oil, and ≤100 mg/kg for some refrigerant types in systems with polyol ester (POE) compressor oil. The actual values are set by the compressor manufacturer, and should be checked and verified during operation by moisture-indicating sight-glass viewing, and yearly by laboratory sample analysis reports. Depending on temperature and velocity, excessive moisture coming to the cooling coil through refrigerant might cause internal freeze-up around the coil's expansion valve. Generally, moisture in a system contributes to forma-

tion of acids, sludge, copper plating, and corrosion. Oil breakdown (by excessive compressor overheat) can form organic, hydrofluoric, and hydrochloric acids in the lubricant oil, all of which can corrode copper.

The refrigerant must be of high quality and meet AHRI *Standard* 700 purity requirements. Application design ratings of the coil or coil bank are based on purity and dryness. This is a primary requirement of refrigerant evaporator coil maintenance.

DX coil replacement often coincides with refrigerant change-out to a chlorine-free refrigerant. Special care should be taken to ensure that the system is retrofitted in accordance with the compressor and refrigerant manufacturers' written procedures.

10. SYMBOLS

A_a = coil face or frontal area, m^2
A_d = dry external surface area, m^2
A_o = total external surface area, m^2
A_p = exposed external prime surface area, m^2
A_s = external secondary surface area, m^2
A_w = wet external surface area, m^2
B = ratio of external to internal surface area, dimensionless
C = coil characteristic as defined in Equations (12) and (23), (kg·K)/kJ
c = heat transfer exponent, or NTU_a, as defined in Equations (31) and (32), dimensionless
c_o = heat transfer exponent, as defined in Equation (7d), dimensionless
c_p = specific heat of humid air = 1.019 kJ/(kg·K) for cooling coils
c_{pw} = specific heat of water = 4.18 kJ/(kg·K)
c_r = specific heat of nonvolatile coolant, kJ/(kg·K)
D_i = tube inside diameter, mm
D_o = tube outside diameter, mm
E_a = air-side effectiveness defined in Equation (7b), dimensionless
F_s = coil core surface area parameter = (external surface area)/(face area) (no. of rows deep)
f = convection heat transfer coefficient, $W/(m^2 \cdot K)$
h = air enthalpy (actual in airstream or saturation value at surface temperature), kJ/kg
Δh_m = mean effective difference of air enthalpy, as defined in Equation (25), kJ/kg
k = thermal conductivity of tube material, W/(m·K)
M = ratio of nonvolatile coolant-to-air temperature changes for sensible heat cooling coils, as defined in Equation (7e), dimensionless
m'' = rate of change of air enthalpy at saturation with air temperature, kJ/(kg·K)
N_r = number of coil rows deep in airflow direction, dimensionless
Δp_{sd} = isothermal dry surface air-side at standard conditions (20°C, 101.325 kPa), Pa
Δp_{sw} = wet surface air-side at standard conditions (20°C, 101.325 kPa), Pa
q = heat transfer capacity, W
q_e = latent heat removed from entering air to condense moisture, kJ/kg
q_s = sensible heat removed from entering air, kJ/kg
q_t = total refrigeration load of cooling and dehumidifying coil, kJ/kg
q_w = sensible heat removed from condensate to cool it to leaving temperature, kJ/kg
R = thermal resistance, referred to external area A_o, $(m^2 \cdot K)/W$
SHR = ratio of air sensible heat to air total heat, dimensionless
t = temperature, °C
Δt_m = mean effective temperature difference, air dry bulb to coolant temperature, K
Δt_{ms} = mean effective temperature difference, surface-to-coolant, K
$\Delta t_{\bar{m}}$ = mean effective temperature difference, air dry bulb to effective surface temperature $t_{\bar{s}}$, K
U_o = overall sensible heat transfer coefficient, $W/(m^2 \cdot K)$
V_a = coil air face velocity at 20°C, m/s
W = air humidity ratio, kilograms of water per kilogram of air
w = mass flow rate, kg/s
y = ratio of nonvolatile coolant temperature rise to airstream enthalpy drop, as defined in Equation (13), (kg·K)/kJ
η = fin effectiveness, as defined in Equation (6), dimensionless
ρ_a = air density = 1.20 kg/m^3 at 20°C at sea level

Superscripts

′ = wet bulb
″ = dew point

Subscripts

1 = condition entering coil
2 = condition leaving coil
a = airstream
ab = air, dry/wet boundary
ad = dry air
aw = wet air
b = dry/wet surface boundary
d = dry surface
e = latent
f = fin (with R); saturated liquid water (with h)
g = saturated water vapor
i = installed, selected (with A_o, N_r)
m = metal (with R) and mean (with other symbols)
md = dry metal
mw = wet metal
o = overall (except for A)
r = coolant
rb = coolant dry/wet boundary
s = surface (with d, t, and w) and saturated (with h)
$\bar{s}$ = effective surface
sb = surface dry/wet boundary
t = tube (with R) and total (with s and q)
td = total heat capacity, dry surface
tw = total heat capacity, wet surface
w = water (with ρ), condensate (with h and subscript number), and wet surface (with other symbols)

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CHAPTER 24

DESICCANT DEHUMIDIFICATION AND PRESSURE-DRYING EQUIPMENT

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DEHUMIDIFICATION is the removal of water vapor from air, gases, or other fluids. There is no pressure limitation in this definition, and sorption dehumidification equipment has been designed and operated successfully for system pressures ranging from subatmospheric to as high as 40 MPa. In common practice, *dehumidification* refers to equipment operating at atmospheric pressures and built to standards similar to other types of air-handling equipment. For drying gases under pressure, or liquids, the term **dryer** or **dehydrator** is normally used.

This chapter mainly covers equipment and systems that dehumidify air rather than those that dry other gases or liquids. Both liquid and solid desiccants are used; they either adsorb water on the desiccant's surface (adsorption) or chemically combine with water (absorption).

Nonregenerative equipment uses hygroscopic salts such as calcium chloride, urea, or sodium chloride. Regenerative systems usually use a form of silica or alumina gel; activated alumina; molecular sieves; or lithium chloride, calcium chloride, or glycol solution. In regenerative equipment, the water removal mechanism is reversible. The choice of desiccant depends on installation requirements, equipment design, and chemical compatibility with the gas to be treated or impurities in the gas. Chapter 32 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* has more information on desiccant materials and how they operate.

Some applications of desiccant dehumidification include

- Ventilating buildings with cooled and dried outdoor air
- Addressing buildings with high internal humidity loads, such as pools, fitness centers, and beverage/food processing
- Keeping buildings and HVAC systems dry to prevent mold growth
- Lowering relative humidity to facilitate manufacturing and handling of hygroscopic materials
- Lowering the dew point to prevent condensation on products manufactured in low-temperature processes
- Providing protective atmospheres for heat treatment of metals
- Controlling humidity in warehouses and caves used for storage
- Preserving ships, aircraft, and industrial equipment that would otherwise deteriorate
- Maintaining a dry atmosphere in a closed space or container, such as the cargo hold of a ship or numerous static applications
- Eliminating condensation and subsequent corrosion
- Speeding drying of heat-sensitive products, such as candy, seeds, and photographic film
- Drying natural gas
- Drying gases that are be liquefied
- Drying instrument and plant air
- Drying process and industrial gases

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.12, Desiccant Dehumidification Equipment and Components.

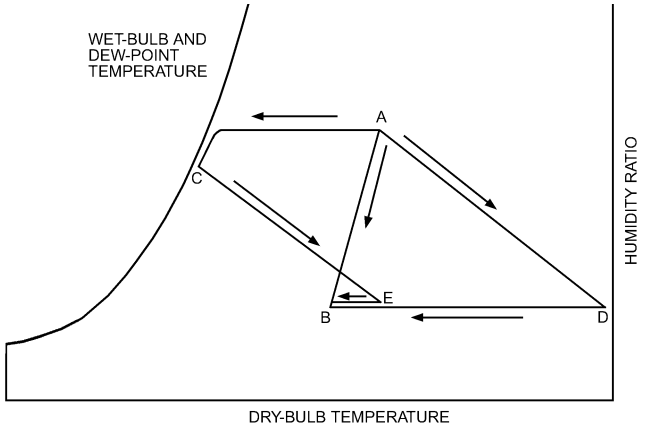


Fig. 1 Methods of Dehumidification

- Dehydration of liquids
- Dehumidifying buildings using chilled beams
- Frost-free cooling for low-temperature process areas such as brewery cellars; blast freezers; and refrigerated warehouses
- Offering frost-free dehumidification for processes that require air at a subfreezing dew-point humidity
- Maintaining low dew points for electronics and battery production
- Maintaining low-dew-point space conditions for surgical suites
- Providing appropriate conditions for pneumatic conveying of hygroscopic materials
- Providing appropriate conditions for engine test cells
- Improving indoor air quality (IAQ)
- Eliminating fog formation and ceiling condensation in ice rinks.
- Minimizing frost build-up on refrigerated display cases in supermarkets.

This chapter covers (1) the types of dehumidification equipment for liquid and solid desiccants, including high-pressure equipment; (2) performance curves; (3) variables of operation; and (4) some typical applications. Using desiccants to dry refrigerants is addressed in Chapter 8 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

1. METHODS OF DEHUMIDIFICATION

Air may be dehumidified by (1) cooling it or increasing its pressure, reducing its capacity to hold moisture, or (2) removing moisture by attracting the water vapor with a liquid or solid desiccant. Frequently, systems use a combination of these methods to maximize operating efficiency and minimize installed cost.

Figure 1 illustrates three methods to dehumidify with desiccant materials or equipment. Air in the condition at Point A is dehumidified

and cooled to Point B. In a liquid-desiccant unit, air is simultaneously cooled and dehumidified directly from Point A to Point B. In a solid-desiccant unit, this process can be completed by precooling and dehumidifying from Point A to Point C, then desiccating from Point C to Point E, and finally cooling to Point B. It could also be done with solid-desiccant equipment by dehumidifying from Point A to Point D and then cooling from Point D to Point B.

Compression

Compressing air reduces its capacity to hold moisture. The resulting condensation reduces the air's moisture content in absolute terms, but produces a saturated condition: 100% relative humidity at elevated pressure. In atmospheric-pressure applications, this method is too expensive, but is worthwhile in pressure systems such as instrument air. Other dehumidification equipment, such as coolers or desiccant dehumidifiers, often follows the compressor to avoid problems associated with high relative humidity in compressed-air lines.

Cooling

Refrigerating air below its dew point is the most common method of dehumidification. This is advantageous when the gas is comparatively warm, has a high moisture content, and the desired outlet dew point is above 5°C. Frequently, refrigeration is combined with desiccant dehumidification to obtain an extremely low dew point at minimum cost.

Liquid Desiccants

Liquid desiccant conditioners (absorbers) contact the air with a liquid desiccant, such as a solution of lithium chloride or glycol (Figures 2A, 2B, and 3), to dehumidify and often cool that air. When the water vapor pressure of such a solution is lower than the partial pressure of water in the surrounding air, the solution will collect moisture, thereby decreasing its concentration and dehumidifying the air. The solution's water vapor pressure is a function of its temperature and concentration. Solutions of higher desiccant concentration and/or lower temperature result in lower water vapor pressures and have a stronger dehumidifying effect on the contacted air.

Conversely, liquid desiccant regenerators also contact the air with the same liquid desiccant. When the water vapor pressure of such a solution is higher than the partial pressure of water in the surrounding air, the solution will reject moisture, thereby increasing its concentration and humidifying the air. Solutions of lower desiccant concentration and/or higher temperature result in higher water vapor pressures and have a humidifying effect on the contacted air.

A simple way to show this relationship is to graph the humidity ratio of air in equilibrium with a liquid desiccant as a function of its concentration and temperature. Figure 4 presents this relationship for lithium chloride/water solutions in equilibrium with air at 101.325 kPa. The graph has the same general shape as a psychrometric chart, with the relative humidity lines replaced by desiccant concentration lines.

To dehumidify air, a first airstream (either outdoor, return, or mixed air) contacts a cooled solution in the conditioner; water condenses into the desiccant solution from the air, and the solution is diluted. The diluted solution is continuously reconcentrated in the regenerator, where it is heated to elevate its water vapor pressure and equilibrium humidity ratio. A second airstream, usually outdoor air, contacts the heated solution in the regenerator; water evaporates from the desiccant solution into the air, and the solution is reconcentrated. Desiccant solution is continuously circulated between the conditioner and regenerator to complete the cycle. Liquid desiccant conditioners typically have high contact efficiency, so air leaves the conditioner at a temperature and humidity ratio very close to the entering temperature and equilibrium humidity ratio of the desiccant.

Liquid desiccants are typically very effective antifreeze. As a result, liquid-desiccant heat pumps can continuously deliver air at subfreezing temperatures without frosting or freezing problems. Lithium chloride/water solution, for example, has a eutectic point below –68°C; liquid desiccant conditioners using this solution can cool air to temperatures as low as –45°C.

LiCl is an ionic salt that is widely used as a liquid desiccant. Other options that have been used include similar salts such as CaCl, which has a more limited operating range but is significantly cheaper. The properties of these and more novel liquid desiccant options are discussed in more detail in Chapter 32 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Liquid desiccant (LD) systems circulate the desiccant between a conditioner that supplies the process air and a regenerator that restores the desiccant concentration by removing the humidity absorbed at the conditioner from the desiccant. The change in concentration is typically 1 to 3% per circulation. Absorption and desorption are driven by vapor pressure differences between the air flowing over the desiccant and the desiccant surface. Effective heat exchangers will therefore have similar vapor pressures in the air at the conditioner and the regenerator, corresponding to similar relative humidity levels. Figure 4 shows the equilibrium relative humidity levels for LD at different temperatures and concentrations, as well as areas where the solution either freezes (concentration <25%, temperatures <<0°C) or crystalizes in different combinations of LiCl and H_2O crystals. Typical supply conditioner requirements are 50% rh, which requires a concentration of about 30% LiCL.

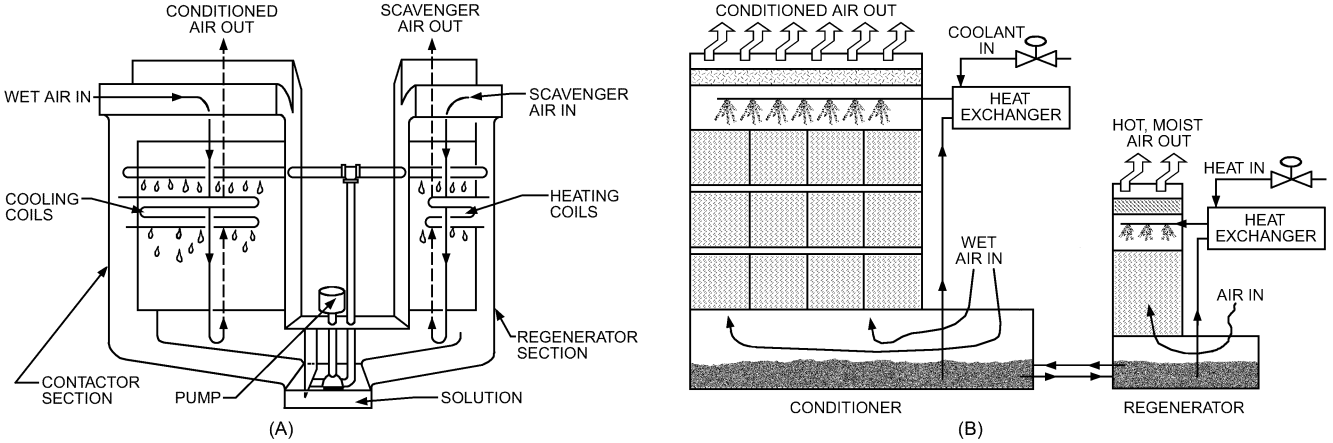


Fig. 2 Flow Diagram for Liquid-Absorbent Dehumidifier (A) Without and (B) With Extended Surface Contact Medium

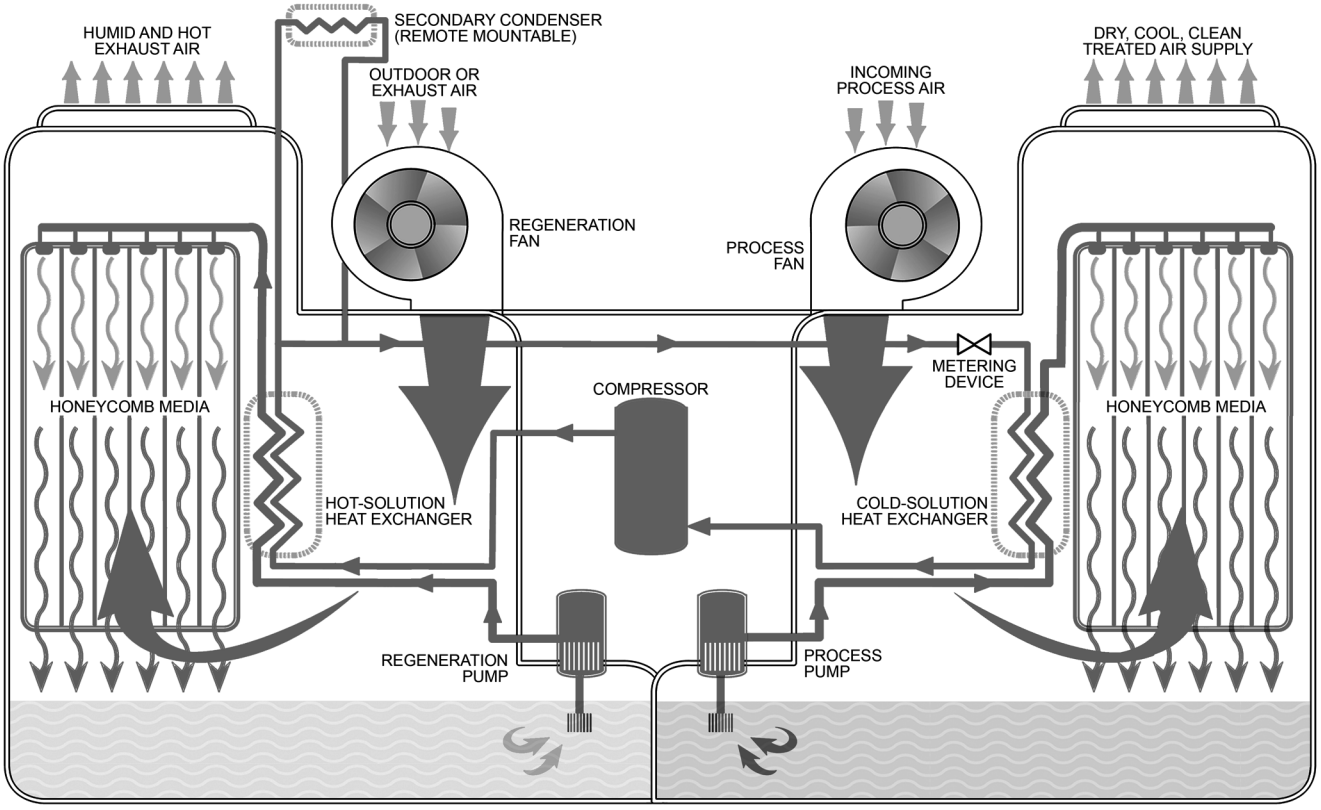


Fig. 3 Flow Diagram for Liquid-Absorbent Unit with Onboard Refrigeration System

LiCl is an effective desiccant and can achieve lower dew-point levels then CaCL and other cheaper alternatives. Since lithium is now widely used in many applications, in particular batteries, pricing has responded to the increased demand. Salts like LiCl and CaCL are also corrosive. As a result, work is being done on other ionic fluids that have less corrosive properties (see Chapter 32 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). These tend to have significantly higher viscosity as well as other differences in properties that require significant redesign.

To deal with the corrosive nature of the desiccant salts like LiCL, liquid desiccant heat exchangers (LDHX) using LiCL are made of polymers and covered with membranes that allow humidity to pass but block the transfer of liquids (i.e., the salt solution).

Internal cooling of the panel is critical. A typical salt solution of 30% can dehumidify air to point B in Figure 5 adiabatically but to point A if the absorption heat is removed by a heat transfer fluid. Solid desiccants can typically dehumidify to much lower relative humidity levels, which makes adiabatic cooling possible. But liquid desiccants typically supply air at 40 to 60% rh, which at temperatures of 35°C results in dew points of 20°C or higher. They are typically cooled using a heat transfer fluid (e.g., water or glycol). Direct cooling with a refrigerant involves pressures that are difficult to handle with noncorrosive materials.

Creating heat exchangers that are internally cooled, with thin layer of desiccant covered on the outside by a membrane, has been a challenging design task, requiring using advanced manufacturing techniques. Recent published results (Wood et al. 2022) show performance within 10% of the modeled theoretical potential of this approach compared to about 50% using earlier solutions.

Figure 5 shows 2003 Conde data comparing theoretical to actual performance for a wide variety of research programs. Actual performance of liquid desiccant systems generally was a fraction of the theoretical potential. After 2010, significant improvements were achieved, resulting in low-flow systems performing close to theoretical performance.

Low-flow systems have a mass flow ratio of desiccant to air of 5 to 20%. This is important for overall performance because the desiccant needs to be moved between regenerator and conditioner. A low mass flow ratio reduces the energy losses that occur in that process. The alternative is a complex desiccant flow management system to increase the delta in concentration between regenerator and conditioner, which affects system costs.

Regeneration using waste heat of a compressor should be able to make efficient use of this heat without overheating the condenser. Regeneration tends to be more efficient at higher temperatures, but those higher temperatures also result in a higher lift and thus lower performance of the compressor. As a result, optimized systems tend to run at moderate concentrations of 25 to 35% LiCL, which can be maintained at condenser temperatures of 38 to 49°C, resulting in a supply air of about 50% rh at 18 to 24°C.

Overall efficiency of compressor-based systems is driven by the fact that they dehumidify to target dew point at much higher temperatures. Condensing systems cool to the dew point. The difference is 15 to 20% in cooling requirements. By using LDHX, compressor systems can avoid reheat by not overcooling the air. The condenser is cooled using a combination of evaporation and sensible cooling, which reduces fan power requirements and reduces overall lift at high load operating conditions. In heat pump mode, systems avoid the need for defrost cycles, which improves heating efficiency and increases the temperature range at which the heat pump can operate efficiently. LDHX can also maintain 30 to 50% rh in the space using humidity available outdoors.

Of course, where waste heat is easily available from fuels cells, cogeneration and other waste heat sources, regeneration can be done at higher temperatures. With such waste heat, systems can dehumid-

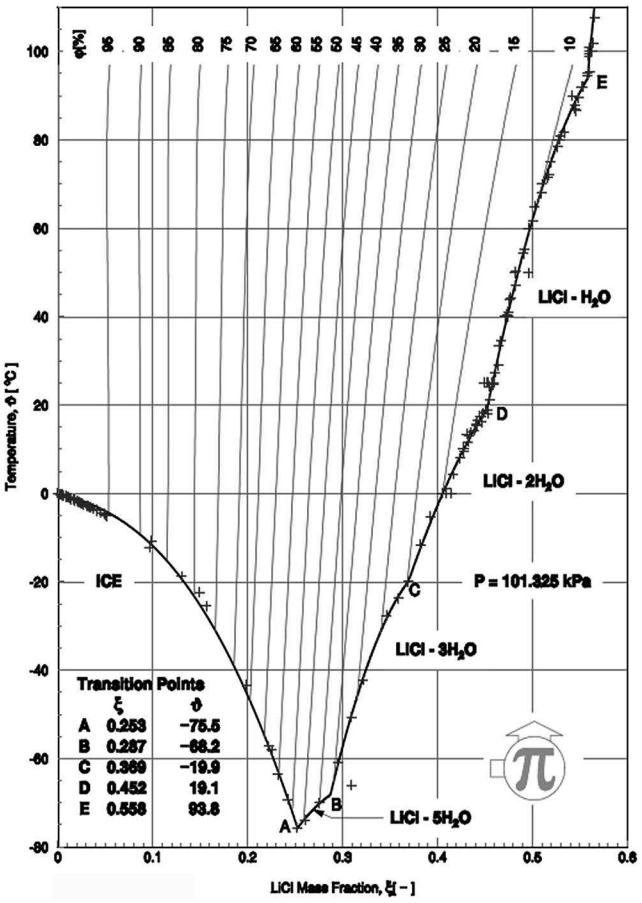


Fig. 4 Lithium Chloride Equilibrium in Air in Psychrometric Diagram

(*Source*: Conde Engineering)

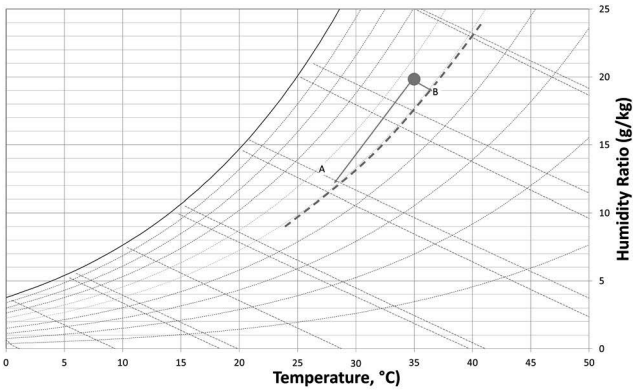


Fig. 5 Liquid Desiccant Panel

(Conde liquid desiccant performance results, 2003)

ify air to 7 to 13°C using cooling tower water at 18 to 24°C. This makes it possible to use evaporative cooling systems in humid climates as well as in desert conditions with very high wet-bulb conditions (see Figure 8).

The cool air from the conditioner and the hot air from the regenerator have approximately the same relative humidity, since the changes in desiccant concentration are within 1 to 2%. Figure 6

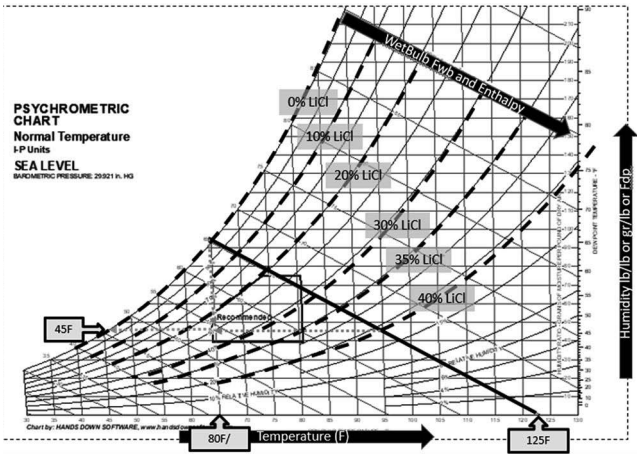


Fig. 6 Lithium Chloride Equilibrium

shows the conditions for lithium chloride where the vapor pressure in the desiccant at a certain concentration balances with a specific concentration. The psychrometric chart shows vertical lines of constant dry-bulb temperature, horizontal lines of constant absolute humidity expressed either in the dew-point temperature, ratio of the mass of the water in the air versus the total mass of the air. The angled lines show constant enthalpy of the air. The lines of constant relative humidity and those for the vapor pressure of the desiccant at a constant concentration are parallel. A concentration of LiCl of 20 to 30% corresponds to a relative humidity of 60 to 40% at 18 to 24°C. Those are target conditions that have shown to be in the health and comfort zone of the psychrometric chart.

Liquid desiccant performance compared to standard DX system is shown in Figure 7. At outdoor air condition A, the liquid desiccant will supply air at condition B and regenerate at condition C. In equilibrium, the moisture removed from the conditioned air needs to be released in the regeneration air. The relative humidity of the supply air and of the regenerator air are similar since they both use the same circulating liquid desiccant. Q_{evap} is the work that the compressor has to do to cool and dehumidify the air from A to B. Q_{evap} plus the waste energy from the compressor I^2R is the energy available for regeneration. The temperature difference between the evaporator and condenser is typically 22 to 28 K. Unlike typical DX systems, condenser airflows tend to comparable or much smaller than evaporator airflows. Effective regeneration at 50% rh requires a temperature over 38°C, with most of the energy dissipated through evaporation. At low loads and cool very humid outside air conditions, regeneration is most effective with low airflows at similar temperatures of 38 to 49°C.

A traditional DX system (dotted lines) needs to cool the air to dew point and needs to do more about 15% more work to cool the air to the target dew point at 100% rh. Condenser airflows tend to be several times larger than airflows at the evaporator and total lift is typically has a larger lift of 33 to 38 K. High capacity condensing coils tend to be deep with high pressure drop, resulting in high fan loads for both conditioner and regenerator.

Figure 8 shows a typical layout of a liquid desiccant system with membrane enabled three-way heat exchangers. It shows the conditioner and regenerator with the liquid desiccant flowing through a heat exchanger. As the liquid desiccant circulates between the cold conditioner and a hot regenerator, the heat exchanger is essential to minimize the heat loss of this circulation. The heat transfer fluid, which can be water, glycol or other high-heat-capacity fluids, is cooled and heated in the evaporator and condenser HX of a com-

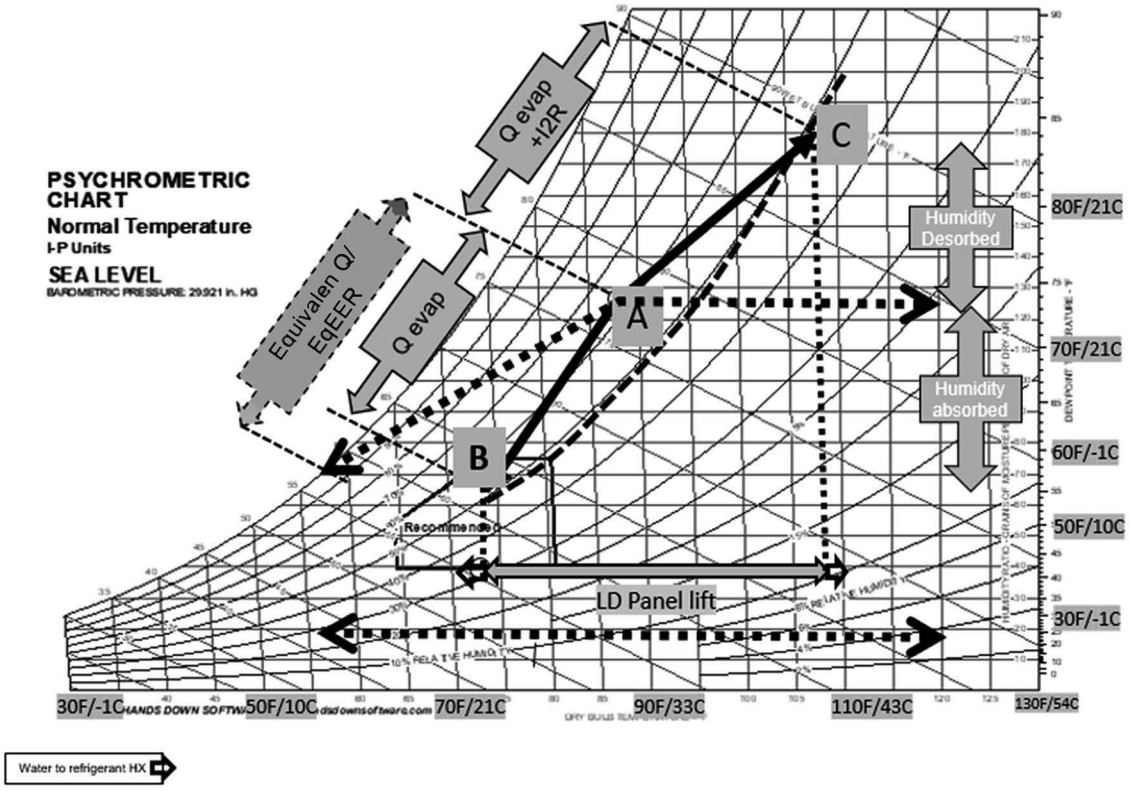


Fig. 7 Liquid Desiccant Performance

pressor. This makes the unit a drop-in replacement for existing DX systems.

The liquid desiccant concentration can be varied by changing the airflow through the regenerator. When more control is needed, air-cooled coils can be added. They reduce or increase the available heat for regeneration. The HDC or heat dump coil rejects compressor heat, reducing the regenerator temperature and thereby lowing the concentration of the desiccant, which increases the relative humidity of the supply air and the SHR of the system.

For humid and cool conditions, a second heat recovery coil (HRC) can be used. This coil cools down the regen air providing additional load for the compressor which allows the regenerator to increase the desiccant concentration. This allows for adiabatic or near adiabatic dehumidification of the conditioned supply air.

Where relative dry exhaust air is available the heat requirements of the regenerator is reduced. This increases system efficiency by 10 to 20% especially during humid and cool conditions.

The system can be used as a heat pump by changing the heat transfer fluid flow, so that the fluid going into the conditioner is heated, while the regenerator dehumidifies and cools the outside air. Alternatively, the refrigerant flow in the compressor can be switched. The cold outside air at the regenerator is dehumidified and cooled. As a result, frost forming and thus frost cycles can be avoided.

The efficiency of the system shown in Figure 8 is improved compared to traditional DX systems by using smaller compressors, with a smaller lift, doing less work to dehumidify the air. In addition, or as an alternative for the compressor, other heat and cold sources can be used. In particular, cooling tower water can be used to manage the dehumidification load of these liquid desiccant systems, with waste, geothermal, or solar heat used for regeneration. This further reduces power requirements for cooling and dehumidification. The fit of these configurations depends on the relative cost and sustainability of electricity versus the availability and cost of waste heat and evaporative cooling sources.

LiCl is widely used as a desiccant given its favorable characteristics at typical outside air and supply air conditions. Alternatives like CaCl and potassium can be used, depending on the application. Because of the corrosive character of the desiccant salts , the heat exchangers are made of polymers to avoid corrosion. The membrane prevents the desiccant from entering the airstream while ensuring that the desiccant is spread out across the surface of the heat exchanger. In addition, mist eliminators can be added if there are concerns about damage to the membranes.

To meet UL 900 requirements the plastic heat exchangers are protected by a low pressure drop fire protector. This is visible in an early version of a three-way membrane-enabled liquid desiccant heat exchanger (Figure 9).

Characteristically, liquid desiccant systems are used where there are significant outside air requirements in humid climates. They perform well when humidity control is important and the system needs to be able to operate at a low or variable SHR. In climates that combine hot and humid conditions during part of the year or day, with extremely hot and dry conditions, the desiccant needs to be diluted to avoid crystallization. This can be done by adding demineralized water directly to the desiccant solution, or by maintaining a high relative humidity in the regenerator, the conditioner, or both by humidifying the outside air with a evaporative pad or misting device.

Where other sources of heating and cooling are available, the desiccant heat exchangers can be used to dehumidify and regenerate the liquid desiccant solution. To maintain the concentration of the desiccant requires that the available regeneration heat is greater than the cooling energy. When used as a DOAS system, the performance of liquid desiccant systems is measured in kg/kW. When overall efficiency is measured the ratio of kilowatts cooling to kilowatts of

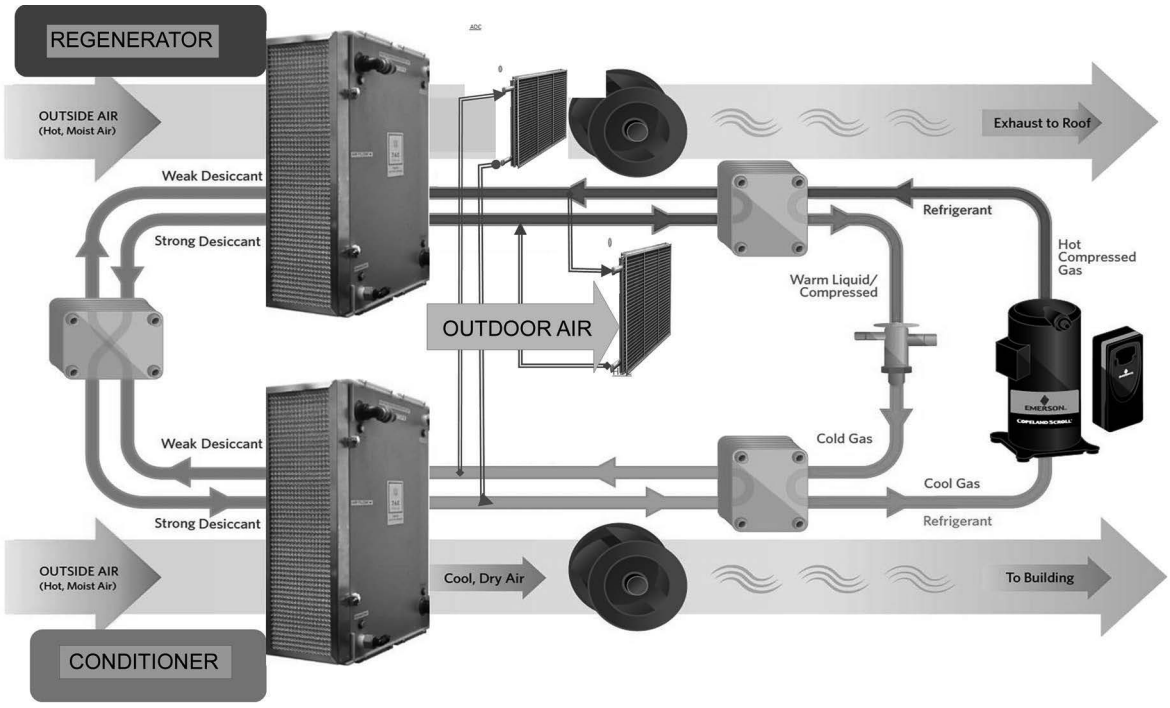


Fig. 8 Liquid Desiccant System Layout

Fig. 9 Three-Way Membrane-Enabled Desiccant Heat Exchanger

(Courtesy Emerson Climate System 2022)

power used by the system can be used, measured at the relevant conditions for that system (i.e., not necessarily at the conditions described in AHRI *Standard* 340).

Performance of liquid desiccant systems can be measured in several ways:

- Liquid desiccant dedicated outside air systems are evaluated based on their performance against the 920 standard, which measures the system **integrated seasonal moisture removal rate (ISMRE)**, a measure of energy required to remove humidity.
- Air handlers using dedicated outdoor air systems can be evaluated using COP or EER, which evaluate the total energy removed or added to air divided by the system energy required to do this work. To measure the advantage that LD systems have in removing humidity at higher operating temperatures, their performance can be best compared to standard systems that condense outdoor air by using an equivalent EER or COP that compares the work done by the unit to the work that would be required by a standard unit cooling the air to the target dew point.
- Heat exchangers can be evaluated using sensible and latent effectiveness. Latent effectiveness is typically measured as the actual change in moisture in the air divided by the delta between the initial moisture level (kg/kg) compared to the moisture removal potential. Typically this is measured by calculating air moisture at a temperature equal to that of the incoming cooling/water fluid and at a vapor pressure equal to that of the liquid desiccant at the concentration entering the heat exchanger. An alternative measure that gives a better comparison to typical heat exchangers measures the target condition based on the temperature and concentration of the liquid desiccant leaving the HX
- Actual system and module performance can be predicted using a physics-based model (Woods et al. 2022), with all the physical properties of the unit. A comparison between that modeled performance and actual performance then shows how close the unit is to the theoretical optimum predicted by the model, which is a good indicator of the maturity of the design. As indicated above, this used to be between 30 and 70% of theoretical performance; however, recent results are much closer at about 90% of theoretical performance. Such measures are critical for evaluating production results and for understanding the trade-offs between system size and complexity and actual performance. In Woods et al. (2022), predicted performance was shown as shown in Figure 10, showing the actual and modeled results for a liquid desiccant system at the four 920 conditions (1 = 920A, 2 = 920B, etc.). For reference, the minimum ISMRE requirement for DOAS systems under the 2019 standard is 1.6 kg/kW.

Solid Sorption

Solid sorption passes air through a bed of granular desiccant or through a structured packing impregnated with desiccant. Humid air passes through the desiccant, which when active has a vapor pressure

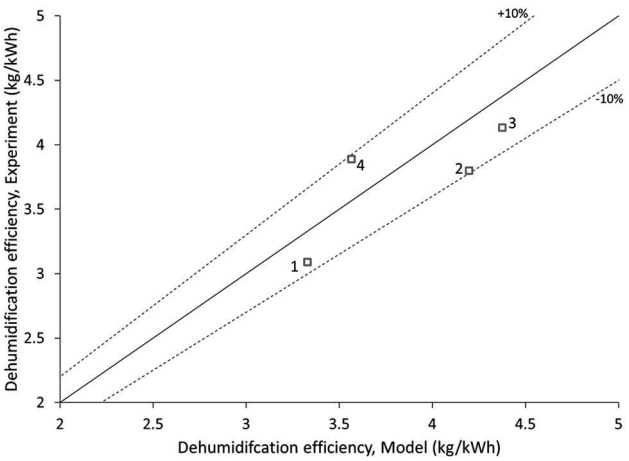


Fig. 10 Predicted Versus Actual Performance of Liquid Desiccant System at Four Standard Conditions

(Woods et al. 2022)

below that of the humid air. This vapor pressure differential drives water vapor from the air onto the desiccant. After becoming loaded with moisture, the desiccant is reactivated (dried out) by heating, which raises the vapor pressure of the material above that of the surrounding air. With the vapor pressure differential reversed, water vapor moves from the desiccant to a second airstream called the *reactivation air*, which carries moisture away from the equipment.

2. DESICCANT DEHUMIDIFICATION

Both liquid and solid desiccants may be used in equipment designed for drying air or other gases at atmospheric or elevated pressures. Regardless of pressure levels, basic principles remain the same.

Desiccant capacity and actual dew-point performance depend on the specific equipment used, characteristics of the various desiccants, initial temperature and moisture content of the gas to be dried, reactivation methods, etc. Factory-assembled units are available up to a capacity of about 38 m^3/s. Greater capacities can be obtained with field-erected units.

2.1 LIQUID DESICCANT EQUIPMENT

Liquid desiccant dehumidifiers are shown in Figures 2 and 3. In Figure 2A, liquid desiccant is distributed onto a cooling coil, which acts as both a contact surface and a means of removing heat released when the desiccant absorbs moisture from the air. In Figure 2B, liquid desiccant is distributed onto an extended heat and mass transfer surface (a packing material similar to that used in cooling towers and chemical reactors). Additionally, Figure 3 demonstrates a liquid desiccant air-conditioning system with an onboard refrigeration system, offering a packaged solution. The packing provides a great deal of surface for air to contact the liquid desiccant, allowing the desiccant to dehumidify and cool the air. It also uses a heat exchanger outside the airstream to cool the desiccant, thereby removing the heat of absorption and any other heat transferred from the air into the desiccant. Air can be passed through the contact surface vertically or horizontally to suit the best arrangement of air system equipment.

Depending on the air and desiccant solution inlet conditions, air can be either simultaneously cooled and dehumidified; heated and dehumidified; heated and humidified; or cooled and humidified. When the enthalpy of the air is to be increased in the conditioner unit, heat must be added either by preheating the air before it enters the conditioner or by heating the desiccant solution with a second heat exchanger. Conversely, when the enthalpy of the air is to be decreased in the conditioner unit, heat must be removed with a heat exchanger. When the air is to be humidified, makeup water is automatically added to the desiccant solution to keep it at the desired concentration. When air is to be dehumidified, a regenerator to reject the collected moisture to an exhaust airstream and a mechanism for transporting the gathered water from the collector to the regenerator are required.

Moisture Removal

In the conditioner, a pump continuously circulates the desiccant solution through a heat exchanger and distributes it over the packed bed contactor surface. The heat exchanger cools the desiccant solution either through an onboard refrigeration system or by transferring heat to an appropriate heat sink such as chilled water, ground water, or other low-temperature heat sink (e.g., even chilled ammonia for extremely low-temperature and low-dew-point applications). This maintains the water vapor pressure of the desiccant used for conditioning lower than that of the air to be treated.

Moisture is absorbed from or desorbed into the air because of the difference in water vapor pressure between the air and the desiccant solution. By controlling the temperature and concentration of the desiccant solution, the conditioner unit can deliver air at a precisely controlled temperature and humidity regardless of inlet air conditions. Therefore, a unit can dehumidify the air during humid weather and humidify it during dry weather. Thus, liquid desiccant conditioners can accurately control humidity without face-and-bypass dampers or after-humidifiers. System performance can easily be controlled as process drying requirements change by altering temperature, concentration, or both to meet the new requirements. Similarly, solution strength can be easily monitored and adjusted while the unit is in operation. The solution strength can be monitored while in operation and can easily be adjusted to compensate for aging. In most cases, the solution retains its effectiveness for the life of the equipment, assuming that proper filtration is maintained.

Heat Removal

When a liquid desiccant absorbs moisture, heat is generated. This heat of absorption consists of the latent heat of condensation of water vapor at the desiccant temperature and the heat of solution (heat of mixing) of the condensed water and the desiccant. The heat of mixing is a function of the equilibrium relative humidity of the desiccant: a lower equilibrium relative humidity produces a greater heat of mixing.

The total heat that must be absorbed by the desiccant solution consists of the (1) heat of absorption, (2) sensible heat associated with reducing the dry-bulb temperature of the air, and (3) residual heat carried to the conditioner by the warm, concentrated desiccant returning from the regenerator unit. This total heat is removed by cooling the desiccant solution in the conditioner heat exchanger (Figure 2B). Any coolant can be used, including cooling tower water, groundwater, seawater, chilled water or brine, and direct-expansion or flooded refrigerants.

Regenerator residual heat, generally called regenerator heat dumpback, can be substantially reduced by using a liquid-to-liquid heat exchanger to precool the warm, concentrated desiccant transferred to the conditioner using the cool, dilute desiccant transferred from the conditioner to the regenerator. This also improves the thermal efficiency of the system, typically reducing coolant and heat input by 10 to 15%.

Regeneration

When the conditioner is dehumidifying, water is automatically removed from the liquid desiccant to maintain the desiccant at the proper concentration. Removal takes place in a separate regenerator. A small sidestream of the desiccant solution is transferred to the regenerator unit. In the regenerator, a separate pump continu-

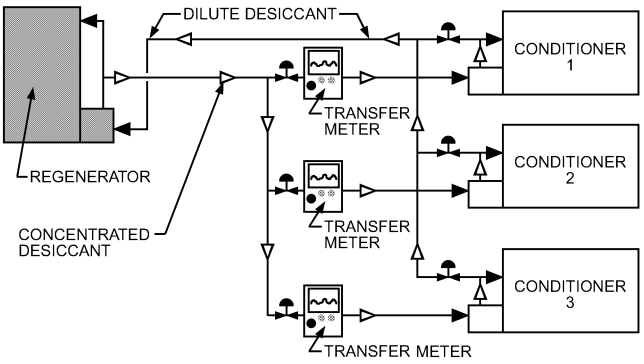


Fig. 11 Liquid Desiccant System with Multiple Conditioners

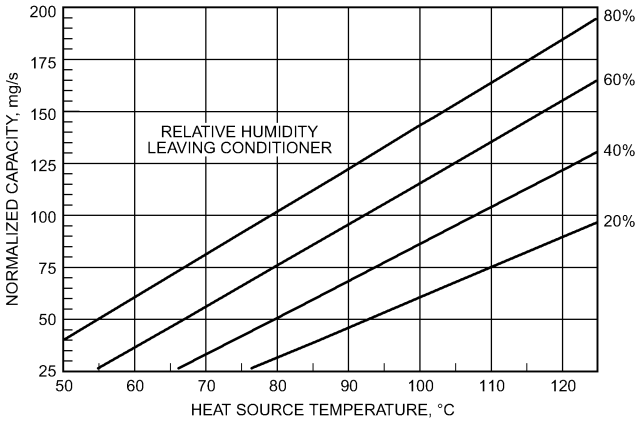


Fig. 12 Liquid Desiccant Regenerator Capacity

ously circulates the desiccant solution through a heat exchanger and distributes it over the packed bed contactor surface. The heat exchanger heats the desiccant solution with waste energy from the onboard compressor system or low-pressure steam or hot water (e.g., from a boiler, solar water heater, or waste heat source) so that the water vapor pressure of the desiccant used for regeneration is substantially higher than that of the outdoor air. Outdoor air is passed through the packing, and water evaporates into it from the desiccant solution, concentrating the solution. The hot, moist air from the regenerator is discharged to the outdoors. A sidestream of concentrated solution is transferred to the conditioner to replace the sidestream of weak solution transferred from the conditioner and completes the cycle.

The regenerator's water removal capacity is controlled to match the moisture load handled by the conditioner. This is accomplished by regulating heat flow to the regenerator heat exchanger to maintain a constant desiccant solution concentration. This is most commonly done by maintaining a constant solution level in the system with a level controller, but specific-gravity or boiling-point controllers are used under some circumstances. Regenerator heat input is regulated to match the instantaneous water removal requirements, so no heat input is required if there is no moisture load on the conditioner. When the conditioner is used to humidify the air, the regenerator fan and desiccant solution pump are typically stopped to save energy.

The conditioner and regenerator can be in a single housing or in separate housings. If in a single housing, the installation, electrical wiring, and equipment cost can be lower than a unit with separate housings. If separated, they can be in different locations and connected by piping; this approach can substantially lower ductwork cost and required mechanical space. Commonly, a single regenerator serves several conditioner units (Figure 11). In the simplest control arrangement, concentrated desiccant solution is metered to each conditioner at a fixed rate. The return flow of weak solution from each conditioner is regulated to maintain a constant operating level in the conditioner. A level controller on the regenerator regulates heat flow to the regenerator solution heater to maintain a constant volume of desiccant solution, and hence a practically constant solution concentration.

The regenerator can be sized to match the dehumidification load of the conditioner unit or units. Regenerator capacity is affected by regenerator heat source temperatures (higher source temperatures increase capacity) and by desiccant concentration (higher concentrations reduce capacity). The relative humidity of air leaving the conditioner is practically constant for a given desiccant concentration, so regenerator capacity can be shown as a function of delivered air relative humidity and regenerator heat source temperature. Figure 12 is a normalized graph showing this relationship. For a given moisture load, various regenerator heat sources may be used if the regenerator is sized for the heat source selected. In many cases, the greater capital cost of a larger regenerator is paid back very quickly by reduced operating cost when a lower-cost or waste-heat source (e.g., condenser heat, especially from the onboard refrigeration system; solar hot water; process or turbine tail stream; jacket heat from an engine-driven generator or compressor) is used.

2.2 SOLID-SORPTION EQUIPMENT

Solid desiccants, such as silica gel, zeolites (molecular sieves), activated alumina, or hygroscopic salts, are generally used to dehumidify large volumes of moist air, and are continuously reactivated. Solid desiccants can also be used in (1) nonreactivated, disposable packages and (2) periodically reactivated desiccant cartridges.

Disposable packages of solid desiccant are often sealed into packaging for consumer electronics, pharmaceutical tablets, and military supplies. Disposable desiccant packages rely entirely on vapor diffusion to dehumidify, because air is not forced through the desiccant. This method is used only in applications where there is no anticipated moisture load at all (such as hermetically sealed packages) because the moisture absorption capacity of any nonreactivated desiccant is rapidly exceeded if a continuous moisture load enters the dehumidified space. Disposable packages generally serve as a form of insurance against unexpected, short-term leaks in small, sealed packages.

Periodically reactivated cartridges of solid desiccant are used where the expected moisture load is continuous, but very small. A common example is the breather, a tank of desiccant through which air can pass, compensating for changes in liquid volume in petroleum storage tanks or drums of hygroscopic chemicals. Air dries as it passes through the desiccant, so moisture will not contaminate the stored product. When the desiccant is saturated, the cartridge is removed and heated in an oven to restore its moisture sorption capacity. Desiccant cartridges are used where there is no requirement for a constant humidity control level and where the moisture load is likely to exceed the capacity of a small, disposable package of desiccant.

Desiccant dehumidifiers for drying liquids and gases other than air often use a variation of this reactivation technique. Two or more pressurized containers of solid desiccant are arranged in parallel, and air is forced through one container for drying, while desiccant in the other container is reactivated. These units are often called dual-tower or twin-tower dehumidifiers.

Continuous reactivation dehumidifiers are the most common type used in high-moisture-load applications such as humidity control systems for buildings and industrial processes. In these units, humid process air is dehumidified in one part of the desiccant bed while a different part of the bed is dried for reuse by a second airstream (reactivation air). The desiccant generally rotates slowly between these two airstreams, so that dry, high-capacity desiccant leaving the reactivation air is always available to remove moisture

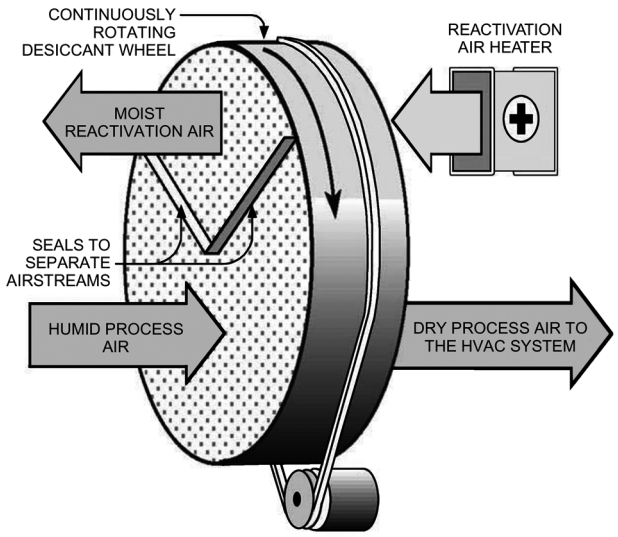


Fig. 13 Typical Rotary Dehumidification Wheel

from the process air. This type of equipment is generally called a rotary desiccant dehumidifier. It is most commonly used in building air-handling systems, and the section on Rotary Solid-Desiccant Dehumidifiers describes its function in greater detail.

2.3 ROTARY SOLID-DESICCANT DEHUMIDIFIERS

Operation

Figure 13 illustrates the principle of operation and arrangement of major components of a typical rotary solid-desiccant dehumidifier. The desiccant can be beads of granular material packed into a bed, or it can be finely divided and impregnated throughout a structured medium. The structured medium resembles corrugated cardboard rolled into a drum, so that air can pass freely through flutes aligned lengthwise through the drum.

In both granular and structured-medium units, the desiccant itself can be either a single material, such as silica gel, or a combination, such as silica gel blended with zeolites. The wide range of dehumidification applications requires flexibility in selecting desiccants to minimize operating and installed costs.

In rotary desiccant dehumidifiers, more than 20 variables can affect performance. In general, equipment manufacturers fix most of these to provide predictable performance in common applications for desiccant systems. Primary variables left to the system designer to define include the following for both process and reactivation air:

- Inlet air temperature
- Moisture content
- Velocity at face of the desiccant bed

In any system, these variables change because of weather, variations in moisture load, and fluctuations in reactivation energy levels. It is useful for the system designer to understand the effect of these normal variations on dehumidifier performance.

Figures 14 to 18 show changes in process air temperature and moisture leaving a generic rotary desiccant dehumidifier as modeled by a finite difference analysis program (Worek and Zheng 1991). Commercial unit performance differs from this model because such units are generally optimized for very deep drying. However, for illustration purposes, the model accurately reflects the relationships between the key variables.

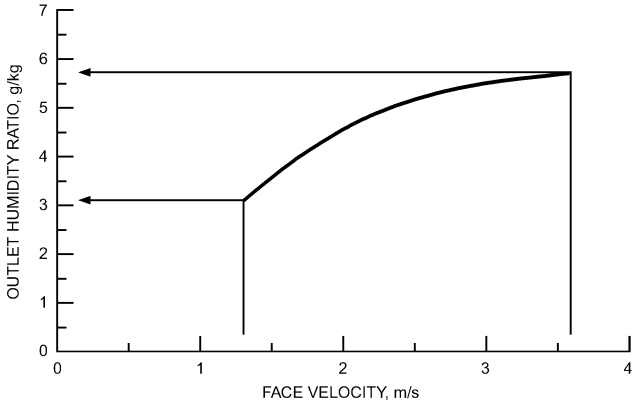


Fig. 14 Effect of Changes in Process Air Velocity on Dehumidifier Outlet Moisture

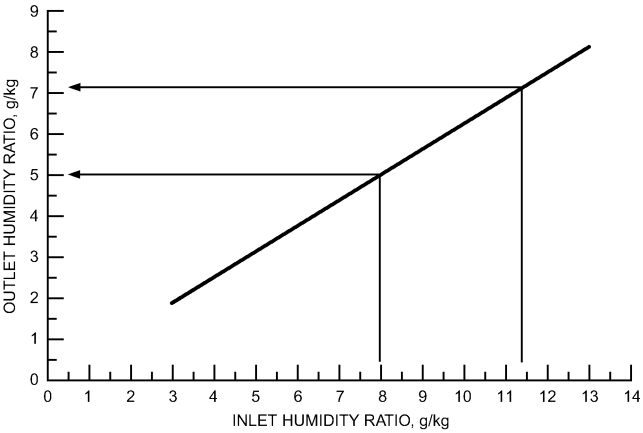


Fig. 15 Effect of Changes in Process Air Inlet Moisture on Dehumidifier Outlet Moisture

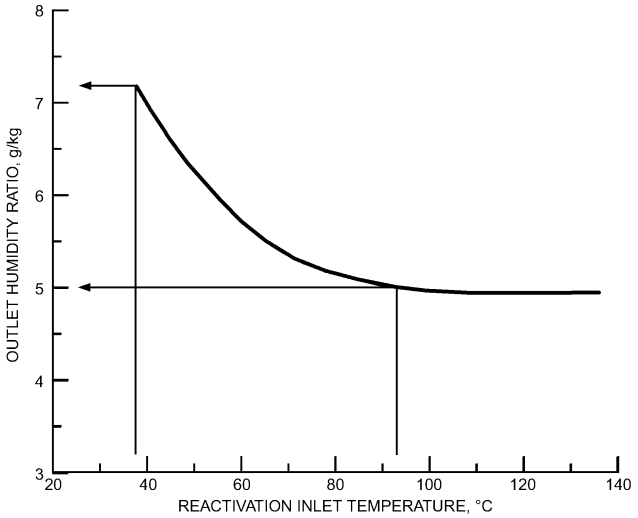


Fig. 16 Effect of Changes in Reactivation Air Inlet Temperature on Dehumidifier Outlet Moisture

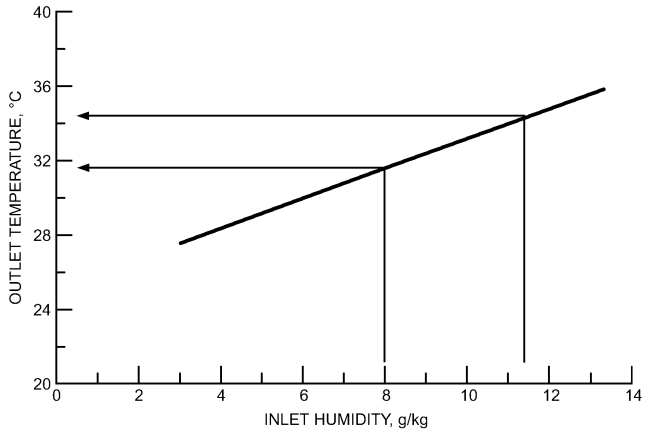


Fig. 17 Effect of Changes in Process Air Inlet Moisture on Dehumidifier Outlet Temperature

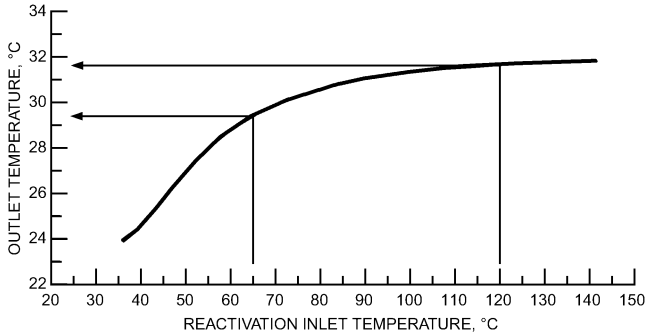


Fig. 18 Effect of Changes in Reactivation Air Inlet Temperature on Dehumidifier Outlet Temperature

The desiccant used for the model is silica gel; the bed is a structured, fluted medium; the bed depth is 400 mm in the direction of airflow; and the ratio of process air to reactivation air is approximately 3:1. **Process air velocity** through the desiccant bed strongly affects leaving moisture. As shown in Figure 14, if the entering moisture is 8.0 g/kg and all other variables are held constant, the outlet moisture varies from 3.1 g/kg at 1.3 m/s to 5.7 g/kg at 3.6 m/s. Thus, air that passes through the bed more slowly is dried more deeply. Therefore, if air must be dried very deeply, a large unit (slower air velocities) must be used.

Process air inlet moisture content affects outlet moisture: if air is more humid entering the dehumidifier, it will be more humid leaving the unit. For example, Figure 15 indicates that, for an inlet humidity of 8.0 g/kg, the outlet humidity is 5.0 g/kg. If inlet moisture content rises to 11.4 g/kg, the outlet humidity rises to 7.1 g/kg. Therefore, if constant outlet humidity is necessary, the dehumidifier needs capacity control unless the process inlet airstream does not vary in temperature or moisture throughout the year (a rare circumstance).

Reactivation air inlet temperature changes the outlet moisture content of the process air. From 38 to 120°C, as more heat is added to the reactivation air, the desiccant dries more completely, which means that it can attract more moisture from the process air (see Figure 16). If reactivation air is only heated to 38°C, process outlet moisture is 7.1 g/kg, or only 0.9 g/kg lower than the entering humidity. In contrast, if reactivation air is heated to 93°C, the outlet moisture is 5.0 g/kg, so that almost 40% of the original moisture is removed.

This relationship has two important consequences. If the design needs dry air, it is generally more economical to use high reactivation air temperatures. Conversely, if leaving humidity from the dehumidifier need not be especially low, inexpensive, low-grade heat sources (e.g., solar heat, waste heat, cogeneration heat, or rejected heat from refrigeration condensers) can be used to reactivate the desiccant.

Process air outlet temperature is higher than the inlet air temperature primarily because the heat of sorption of moisture removed from the air is converted to sensible heat. The heat of sorption includes the latent heat of condensation of the removed moisture, plus additional chemical heat, which varies depending on the desiccant type and process air outlet humidity. Also, some heat is carried over to the process air from the reactivation sector because the desiccant is warm as it enters the relatively cooler process air. Generally, 80 to 90% of the temperature rise of process air is from the heat of sorption, and the balance is from heat carried over from reactivation.

Process outlet temperature versus inlet humidity is shown in Figure 17. Note that as more moisture is removed (higher inlet humidity), outlet temperature rises. Air entering at room comfort conditions of 21°C, 8.0 g/kg leaves the dehumidifier at 31.7°C. If the dehumidifier removes more moisture, such as when the inlet humidity is 11.4 g/kg, outlet temperature rises to 34.4°C. The increase in temperature rise is roughly proportional to the increase in moisture removal.

Process outlet temperature versus reactivation air temperature is shown in Figure 18, which shows the effect of increasing reactivation temperature when the moisture content of the process inlet air stays constant. If the reactivation sector is heated to elevated temperatures, more moisture is removed on the process side, so the temperature rise from latent-to-sensible heat conversion is slightly greater. In this constant-moisture inlet situation, if the reactivation sector is very hot, more heat is carried from reactivation to process as the desiccant mass rotates from reactivation to process. Figure 18 shows that if reactivation air is heated to 65°C, the process air leaves the dehumidifier at 29.4°C. If reactivation air is heated to 120°C, the process air outlet temperature rises to 31.6°C. The 2.2 K increase in process air temperature is primarily caused by the increase in heat carried over from reactivation.

One consequence of this relationship is that desiccant equipment manufacturers constantly seek to minimize the "waste mass" in a desiccant dehumidifier, to avoid heating and cooling extra, nonfunctional material such as heavy desiccant support structures or extra desiccant that air cannot reach. Theoretically, the most efficient desiccant dehumidifier has an infinitely large effective desiccant surface combined with an infinitely low mass.

Use of Cooling

In process drying applications, desiccant dehumidifiers are sometimes used without additional cooling because the temperature increase from dehumidification helps the drying process. In semiprocess applications such as controlling frost formation in supermarkets, excess sensible cooling capacity may be present in the system as a whole, so warm air from a desiccant unit is not a major consideration. However, in most other applications for desiccant dehumidifiers, provision must be made to remove excess sensible heat from process air after dehumidification.

In a liquid-desiccant system, heat is removed by cooling the liquid desiccant itself, so process air emerges from the desiccant medium at the appropriate temperature. In a solid-desiccant system, cooling is accomplished downstream of the desiccant bed with cooling coils. The source of this cooling can affect the system's operating economics.

In some systems, postcooling is accomplished in two stages, with cooling tower water as the primary source followed by compression or absorption cooling. Alternatively, various combinations of indirect and direct evaporative cooling equipment are used to cool the dry air leaving the desiccant unit.

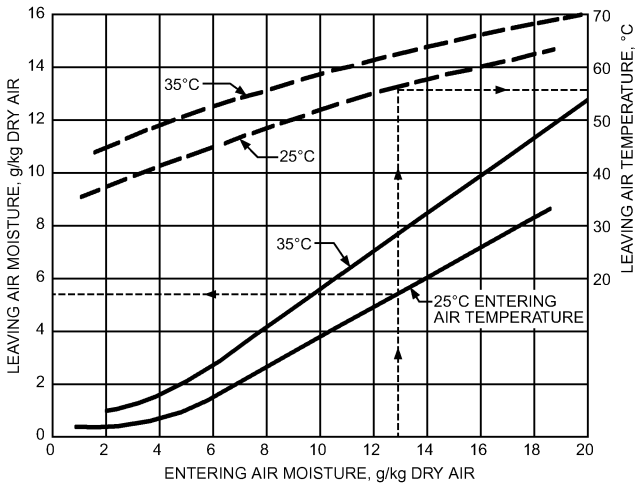


Fig. 19 Typical Performance Data for Rotary Solid Desiccant Dehumidifier

In systems where the latent and sensible loads peak at different times, the sensible cooling capacity of the basic air-conditioning system is sufficient to handle the process air temperature rise without additional equipment. Systems in moderate climates with high ventilation requirements often combine high latent loads in the morning, evening, and night with high sensible loads at midday, so desiccant subsystems to handle latent loads are especially economical.

Using Units in Series

Solid-desiccant dehumidifiers are often used to provide air at low dew points. Applications requiring large volumes of air at moisture contents of 0.7 g/kg (–18°C dew point) are quite common and can be easily achieved by rotary desiccant units in a single pass beginning with inlet moisture contents as high as 6.5 g/kg (7.5°C dew point). Some solid-desiccant units commonly deliver air at 0.3 g/kg (–28°C dew point) without special design considerations. Where extremely low dew points must be achieved, or where air leakage inside the unit may be a concern, two desiccant dehumidifiers can be placed in series, with dry air from one unit feeding both process and reactivation air to a second unit. The second unit delivers very dry air, because there is reduced risk of moisture being carried over from reactivation to process air when dry air is used to reactivate the second unit.

Industrial Rotary Desiccant Dehumidifier Performance

Figures 14 to 18 are based on the generalized model of a desiccant dehumidifier described by Worek and Zheng (1991). The model, however, differs somewhat from commercial products. Figure 19 shows typical performance of an industrial desiccant dehumidifier.

2.4 EQUIPMENT RATINGS

ASHRAE *Standard* 139 describes the parameters used in the desiccant industry to calculate desiccant dehumidifier performance:

- Moisture removal capacity (MRC)
- Regeneration specific heat input (RSHI)
- Process outlet temperature
- Pressure drop through the wheel

These performance parameters can be obtained from any manufacturer by means of performance curves or selection software. However, they are generally rated at sea-level conditions.

ASHRAE research project RP-1339 (Fumo and Mago 2011) investigated how the performance parameters are affected by altitude. The main objectives were to test a desiccant dehumidifier both at sea level and at altitude, and then to develop a general methodology that can be applied to any desiccant wheel to estimate performance at altitude. The test results showed that, by keeping process and regeneration mass flow rates, inlet temperature, and inlet humidity ratio constant between sea level and altitude, performance of a solid-desiccant dehumidifier at altitudes up to 1524 m is constant regardless of altitude, except for pressure drop through the desiccant wheel. Therefore, the MRC, RSHI, and process-out temperature obtained from the manufacturer's performance data at sea level do not require correction for altitude.

Note that, when air at altitude is near saturation, its humidity ratio can be above saturation at sea level. In this situation, determine the relative humidity of the air at altitude and use the same mass flow rate, temperature, and relative humidity with the manufacturer's sea-level performance data when determining MRC and process outlet temperature. The humidity ratio change (grain depression) used to calculate MRC will be the same at altitude and should be subtracted from the inlet humidity ratio at altitude to determine the exit condition.

The pressure drop through the wheel obtained from the manufacturer's performance data at sea level must be corrected by the ratio of atmospheric pressure at sea level and altitude using the density ratio methodology:

$$\Delta P_z = \frac{\rho_0}{\rho_z}\Delta P_0$$

or

$$\Delta P_z = \frac{1}{(1 - 2.25577 \times 10^{-5} Z)^{5.2559}}\Delta P_0$$

where

ΔP_z = wheel pressure drop at altitude, kPa
ΔP_0 = wheel pressure drop at sea level, kPa
ρ_z = moist air density at altitude, kg/m^3
ρ_0 = moist air density at sea level, kg/m^3
Z = elevation, m

The following example shows the method for rating desiccant equipment at altitude.

Example 1. Find the exit air humidity ratio and wheel pressure drop for a dehumidifier operating at Denver International Airport with process air precooled to 12.78°C and 98.0% rh.

Solution: Design inlet conditions are based on the 1% design conditions from Chapter 14 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Site altitude:	1655 m
Process flow rate	1359 m^3/h
Process inlet humidity ratio W_{pi}	11.08 g/kg
Regeneration flow rate	454 m^3/h
Regeneration inlet temperature	19.9°C (before heater)
Regeneration inlet humidity ratio W_{ri}	13.17 g/kg (73.5% rh)
Regeneration inlet temperature	120°C (after heater)

Convert humidity ratios at altitude to equivalent values at sea level.

Process airstream:	
Dry-bulb temperature:	12.78°C
Relative humidity	98%
Humidity ratio W_p	9.04 g/kg
Regeneration airstream:	
Dry-bulb temperature:	19.9°C
Relative humidity	73.8%
Humidity ratio W_r	10.75 g/kg

Obtain sea-level performance data from dehumidifier manufacturer using above psychrometric inputs.

Process airstream out:

Dry-bulb temperature:	36.5°C
Humidity ratio W_{po}	2.24 g/kg
Pressure drop	157 Pa

Regeneration airstream out:

Dry-bulb temperature:	48.9°C
Humidity ratio W_{ro}	31.06 g/kg
Pressure drop	214 Pa

Calculate humidity ratio change and MRC, where

$$\text{MRC} = \text{m}^3/\text{h} \times 0.0012 \times \Delta W_p = \text{kg/h}$$

$$\Delta W_p = 9.04 - 2.24 = 6.8 \text{ g/kg}$$

$$\Delta W_r = 31.06 - 10.75 = 20.31 \text{ g/kg}$$

$$\text{MRC} = 1360 \times 0.0012 \times 6.8 = 11.09 \text{ kg/h}$$

Restate outlet conditions for altitude.

$$W_{po,z} = W_{pi,z} - \Delta W_p = 11.08 - 6.8 = 4.27 \text{ g/kg}$$
$$W_{ro,z} = W_{ri,z} + \Delta W_r = 13.17 + 20.31 = 33.48 \text{ g/kg}$$
$$\text{MRC}_z = \text{MRC}_0 = 11.09 \text{ kg/h}$$

Restate wheel pressure drops for altitude.

$$\Delta P_{p,z} = \frac{1}{1 - 2.25577 \times 10^{-5}(1655)^{5.2559}}(157) = 192 \text{ Pa}$$

$$\Delta P_{r,z} = \frac{1}{1 - 2.25577 \times 10^{-5}(1655)^{5.2559}}(214) = 262 \text{ Pa}$$

2.5 EQUIPMENT OPERATING RECOMMENDATIONS

Desiccant equipment tends to be very durable if maintained properly, often operating at high efficiency 30 years after it was originally installed. Required maintenance is specific to the type of desiccant equipment, the application, and the installation. Each system requires a somewhat different maintenance and operational routine. The information in this section does not substitute for or supersede any recommendations of equipment manufacturers, and it is not a substitute for owners' experience with specific applications.

Process Air Filters

Clean filters are the most important item in a maintenance routine. If a solid desiccant is clogged with particulates, or if a liquid desiccant's sorption characteristics are changed by entrained particulates, the material may have to be replaced prematurely. Filters are much less expensive and much easier to change than the desiccant. Although each application is different, the desiccant usually must be replaced, replenished, or reconditioned after 5 to 10 years of operation. Without attention to filters, desiccant life can be reduced to 1 or 2 years of operation or less. Filters should be checked at least four times per year, and more frequently when airstreams are heavily laden with particulates. Differential pressure sensors across the filter bank to detect loading and alarm a building management system (BMS) may be an alternative to manual inspection.

The importance of filter maintenance requires that filter racks and doors on desiccant systems be freely accessible and that enough space be allowed to inspect, remove, and replace filters. Optimal design ensures that filter locations, as well as the current condition of each filter, are clearly visible to maintenance personnel.

Reactivation/Regeneration Filters

Air is filtered before entering the heater of a desiccant unit. If filters are clogged and airflow is reduced, unit performance may be reduced because there is not enough air to carry all the moisture away from the desiccant. If electrical elements or gas burners are used to heat the air, reducing airflow may damage the heaters. Thus, the previous suggestions for maintaining process air filters also apply to reactivation/regeneration filters.

Liquid-Phase Strainers

In liquid-desiccant systems, clean strainers are an important item in a maintenance routine. Depending on the atmospheric cleanliness and air-phase filtration used, strainers in both the process and regeneration desiccant systems require rinsing every 3 to 6 months.

Reactivation/Regeneration Ductwork

Air leaving the reactivation/regeneration section is hot and moist. When units first start up in high-moisture-load applications, the reactivation air may be nearly saturated and even contain water droplets. Thus, ductwork that carries air away from the unit should be corrosion resistant, because condensation can occur inside the ducts, particularly if the ducts pass through unheated areas in cool weather. If heavy condensation seems probable, the ductwork should be designed with drains at low points or arranged to let condensation flow out of the duct where the air is vented to the weather. The high temperature and moisture of the leaving air may make it necessary to use dedicated ductwork, rather than combining the air with other exhaust airflows, unless the other flows have similar characteristics.

Leakage

All desiccant units produce dry air in part of the system. If humid air leaks into either the dry air ductwork or the unit itself, system efficiency is reduced. Energy is also wasted if dry air leaks out of the distribution duct connections. Therefore, duct connections for desiccant systems should be sealed tightly. In applications requiring very low dew points (below –12°C), the ductwork and desiccant system are almost always tested for leaks at air pressures above those expected during normal operation. In applications at higher dew points, similar leak testing is considered good practice and is recommended by many equipment manufacturers.

Because desiccant equipment tends to be durably constructed, workers often drill holes in the dehumidifier unit casing to provide support for piping, ductwork, or instruments. Such holes eventually leak air, desiccant, or both. Designers should provide other means of support for external components so contractors do not puncture the system unnecessarily.

Contractors installing desiccant systems should be aware that any holes made in the system must be sealed tightly using both mechanical means and sealant compounds. Sealants must be selected for long life at the working temperatures of the application and of the casing walls that have been punctured. For example, reactivation/regeneration sections often operate in a range from a cold winter ambient of –40°C to a heated temperature as high as 150°C. Process sections may operate in a range of –40°C at the inlet to 65°C at the outlet.

Airflow Indication and Control

As explained in the section on Rotary Solid-Desiccant Dehumidifiers, performance depends on how quickly air passes through the desiccant; changes in air velocity affect performance. Thus, it is important to quantify the airflow rate through both the process and reactivation/regeneration parts of the unit. Unless both airflows are known, it is impossible to determine whether the unit is operating properly. In addition, if velocity exceeds the maximum design value, the air may carry desiccant particles or droplets out of the unit and into the supply air ductwork. Thus, manufacturers often provide airflow gages on larger equipment so the owner can be certain the unit is operating within the intended design parameters.

Smaller equipment is not always provided with airflow indicators because precise performance may be less critical in applications such as small storage rooms. However, in any system using large

equipment, or if performance is critical in smaller systems, unit airflow should be quantified and clearly indicated, so operating personnel can compare current flow rates through the system with design values.

Many desiccant units are equipped with manual or automatic flow control dampers to control the airflow rate. If these are not provided with the unit, they should be installed elsewhere in the system. Airflows for process and reactivation/regeneration must be correctly set after all ductwork and external components are attached, but before the system is put into use.

Commissioning

Heat and moisture on the dry-air side of desiccant equipment is balanced equally by the heat and moisture on the regeneration/reactivation side. To confirm that a solid-desiccant system is operating as designed, the commissioning technician must measure airflow, temperature, and moisture on each side to calculate a mass balance. In liquid systems, these six measurements are taken on the process-air side. On the regenerator side, the liquid temperature is read in the sump and at the spray head to confirm the regenerator's heat transfer rate at peak-load conditions.

If the dehumidification unit does not provide the means, the system should be designed to facilitate taking the readings that are essential to commissioning and troubleshooting. Provisions must be made to measure flow rates, temperatures, and moisture levels of airstreams as they enter and leave the desiccant. For liquid systems, provisions must be made for measuring the solution temperature and concentration at different points in the system. Four precautions for taking these readings at different points in a desiccant system follow.

Airflow. Airflow instruments measure the actual volumetric flow rate, which must be converted to standard flow rate to calculate mass flow. Because temperatures in a desiccant system are often well above or below standard temperature, these corrections are essential.

Air Temperature. Most airstreams in a desiccant system have temperatures between –20 and 150°C, but temperature can be widely varied and stratified as air leaves the desiccant in solid-desiccant systems. Air temperature readings must be averaged across the duct for accurate calculations. Readings taken after a fan tend to be more uniform, but corrections must be made for heat added by the fan itself.

Process Air Moisture Leaving Dry Desiccant. In solid-desiccant equipment, air leaving the desiccant bed or wheel is both warm and dry: usually below 20% rh, often below 10%, and occasionally below 2%. Most low-cost instruments have limited accuracy below 15% rh, and all but the most costly instruments have an error of ±2% rh. Consequently, to measure relative humidities near 2%, technicians use very accurate instruments such as manual dew cups or automated optical dew-point hygrometers. ASHRAE *Standard* 41.6 describes these instruments and procedures for their proper use. When circumstances do not allow the use of dew-point instruments, other methods may be necessary. For example, an air sample may need to be cooled to produce a higher, more easily measured relative humidity.

Low humidity readings can be difficult to take with wet-bulb thermometers because the wet wick dries out very quickly, sometimes before the true wet-bulb reading is reached. Also, when the wet-bulb temperature is below the freezing point of water, readings take much longer, which may allow the wick to dry out, particularly in solid-desiccant systems where there may be considerable heat in the air leaving the desiccant. Therefore, wicks must be monitored for wetness. Many technicians avoid wet-bulb readings in air leaving a solid-desiccant bed, partly for these reasons, and partly because of the difficulty and time required to obtain average readings across the whole bed.

Like air temperature, air moisture level leaving a solid-desiccant bed varies considerably; if taken close to the bed, readings must be averaged to obtain a true value for the whole air mass.

When very low dew points are expected, the commissioning technician should be especially aware of limitations of the air-sampling system and the sensor. Even the most accurate sensors require more time to come to equilibrium at low dew points than at moderate moisture levels. For example, at dew points below –30°C, the sensor and air sample tubing may take many hours rather than a few minutes to equilibrate with the air being measured. Time required to come to equilibrium also depends on how much moisture is on the sensor before it is placed into the dry airstream. For example, taking a reading in the reactivation/regeneration outlet essentially saturates the sensor, so it will take much longer than normal to equilibrate with the low relative humidity of the process leaving air.

Reactivation/Regeneration Air Moisture Leaving Desiccant. Air leaving the reactivation/regeneration side of the desiccant is warm and close to saturation. If the humidity measurement sensor is at ambient temperature, moisture may condense on its surface, distorting the reading. It is good practice to warm the sensor (e.g., by taking the moisture reading in the warm, dry air of the process-leaving airstream) before reading moisture in reactivation air. If a wet-bulb instrument is used, water for the wet bulb must be at or above the dry-bulb temperature of the air, or the instrument will read lower than the true wet-bulb temperature of the air.

Owners' and Operators' Perspectives

Designers and new owners are strongly advised to consult other equipment owners and the manufacturer's service department early in design to gain the useful perspective of direct operating experience (Harriman 2003).

2.6 APPLICATIONS FOR ATMOSPHERIC-PRESSURE DEHUMIDIFICATION

Preservation of Materials in Storage

Special moisture-sensitive materials are sometimes kept in dehumidified warehouses for long-term storage. Tests by the Bureau of Supplies and Accounts of the U.S. Navy (DOD 1987, 2004) concluded that 40% rh is a safe level to control deterioration of materials. Others (Sterling et al. 1985) have indicated that 60% rh is low enough to control microbiological attack. With storage at 40% rh, no undesirable effects on metals or rubber compounds have been noted. Some organic materials such as sisal, hemp, and paper may lose flexibility and strength, but they recover these characteristics when moisture is regained.

Commercial storage relies on similar equipment for applications that include beer fermentation rooms, meat storage, and penicillin processing, as well as storage of machine tools, candy, food products, furs, furniture, seeds, paper stock, and chemicals. For recommended conditions of temperature and humidity, refer to Chapters 21 and 28 to 42 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

Process Dehumidification

Requirements for dehumidification in industrial processes are many and varied. Some of these processes are as follows:

- Metallurgical processes, with controlled-atmosphere annealing of metals
- Conveying hygroscopic materials
- Film drying
- Manufacturing candy, chocolate, and chewing gum
- Manufacturing drugs and chemicals
- Manufacturing plastic materials
- Manufacturing laminated glass
- Packaging moisture-sensitive products

- Assembling motors and transformers
- Solid propellant mixing
- Manufacturing electronic components, such as transistors and microwave components
- Processing poultry and other meats
- Processing food and other powders

For information about the effect of low-dew-point air on drying, refer to Chapters 20, 22, 25, and 30 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Ventilation Air Dehumidification

Over a full year, ventilation air loads a cooling system with much more moisture than heat. Except in desert and high-altitude regions, ventilation moisture loads in the United States exceed sensible loads by at least 3:1, and often by as much as 5:1 (Harriman et al. 1997). Consequently, desiccant systems are used to dehumidify ventilation air before it enters the main air-conditioning system.

Drying ventilation air has gained importance because building codes mandate larger amounts of ventilation air than in the past, in an effort to improve indoor air quality. Large amounts of humid ventilation air carry enough moisture to upset the operation of high-efficiency cooling equipment, which is generally designed to remove more sensible heat than moisture (Kosar et al. 1998). Removing excess moisture from the ventilation air with a ventilation dehumidification system improves both humidity control and cooling system effectiveness. For example, field tests suggest that when the environment is kept dry, occupants prefer warmer temperatures, which in turn saves cooling operational costs (Fischer and Bayer 2003). Also, cooling equipment is often oversized to remove ventilation-generated moisture. Predrying with a desiccant system may reduce the building's construction cost, if excess cooling capacity is removed from the design (Spears and Judge 1997).

Figures 20, 21, and 22 show the relative importance of moisture load from ventilation, how a commercial building can use a desiccant system to remove that load, and how such a system is applied in the field (Harriman et al. 2001).

Ventilation dehumidification is most cost effective for buildings with high ventilation airflow rather than high sensible loads from internal heat or from heat transmitted through the building envelope. As a result, this approach is most common in densely occupied buildings such as schools, theaters, elder care facilities, large-scale retail buildings, and restaurants (Harriman 2003).

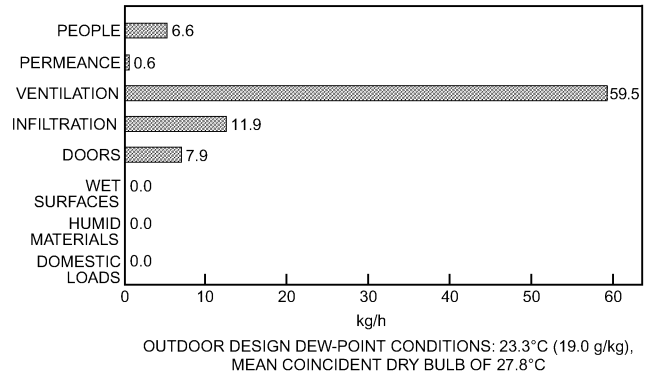


Fig. 20 Typical Peak Moisture Loads for Medium-Sized Retail Store in Atlanta, Georgia

(Harriman et al. 2001)

Condensation Prevention

Many applications require moisture control to prevent condensation. Airborne moisture condenses on cold cargo in a ship's hold when it reaches a moist climate. Moisture condenses on a ship when the moist air in its cargo hold is cooled by the hull and deck plates as the ship passes from a warm to a cold climate.

A similar problem occurs when aircraft descend from high, cold altitudes into a high dew point at ground level. Desiccant dehumidifiers are used to prevent condensation inside the airframe and avionics that leads to structural corrosion and failure of electronic components.

In pumping stations and sewage lift stations, moisture condenses on piping, especially in the spring when the weather warms and water in the pipes is still cold. Dehumidification is also used to prevent airborne moisture from dripping into oil and gasoline tanks and open fermentation tanks.

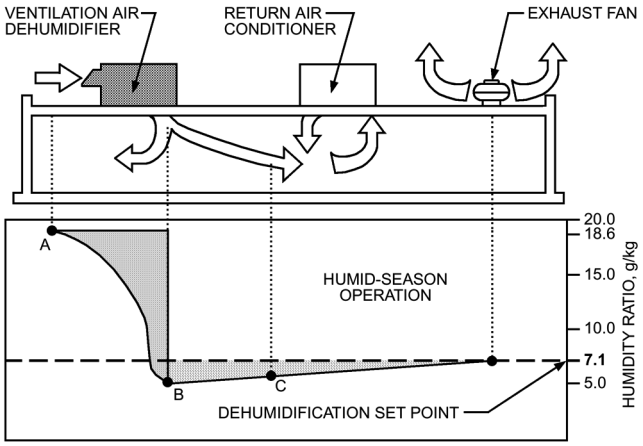
Electronic equipment is often cooled by refrigeration, and dehumidifiers are required to prevent internal condensation of moisture. Electronic and instrument compartments in missiles are purged with low-dew-point air before launching to prevent malfunctioning caused by condensation.

Waveguides and radomes are also usually dehumidified, as are telephone exchanges and relay stations. For proper operation of their components, missile and radar sites depend largely on prevention of condensation on interior surfaces.

Dry Air-Conditioning Systems

Cooling-based air-conditioning systems remove moisture from air by condensing it onto cooling coils, producing saturated air at a lower absolute moisture content. In many circumstances, however, there is a benefit to using a desiccant dehumidifier to remove the latent load from the system, avoiding problems caused by condensation, frost, and high relative humidity in air distribution systems.

For example, low-temperature product display cases in supermarkets operate less efficiently when humidity in the store is high because condensate freezes on the cooling coils, increasing operating cost. Desiccant dehumidifiers remove moisture from the air, using rejected heat from refrigeration condensers to reduce the cost of desiccant reactivation. Combining desiccants and conventional



A. OUTDOOR AIR
Hot and humid in summertime, it must be cooled and dehumidified.

B. VENTILATION DEHUMIDIFIER
Dries incoming air to a condition below the desired humidity set point.

C. DRY VENTILATION AIR
Removes moisture loads generated inside building.

Fig. 21 Predrying Ventilation Air to Dehumidify a Commercial Building

(Harriman et al. 2003)

cooling can lower installation and operating costs (Calton 1985). For information on the effect of humidity on refrigerated display cases, see Chapter 15 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* and Chapter 2 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Air conditioning in hospitals, nursing homes, and other medical facilities is particularly sensitive to biological contamination in condensate drain pans, filters, and porous insulation inside ductwork. These systems often benefit from drying ventilation air with a desiccant dehumidifier before final cooling. Condensate does not form on cooling coils or drain pans, and filters and duct lining stay dry so that mold and mildew cannot grow inside the system. Refer to ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 for guidance concerning maximum relative humidity in air distribution systems. Chapter 8 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* has information on ventilation of health care facilities.

Hotels and large condominium buildings historically suffer from severe mold and mildew problems caused by excessive moisture in the building structure. Desiccant dehumidifiers are sometimes used to dry ventilation air so it can act as a sponge to remove moisture from walls, ceilings, and furnishings (AHMA 1991). Dehumidified ventilation air that positively pressurizes the building may help counter moist air infiltration. See Chapter 6 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information on ventilating hotels and similar structures.

Like supermarkets, ice rinks have large exposed cold surfaces that condense and freeze moisture in the air, particularly during spring and summer. Desiccant dehumidifiers remove excess humidity from air above the rink surface, preventing fog and improving both the ice surface and operating economics of the refrigeration plant. For recommended temperature and humidity for ice rinks, see Chapter 44 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

Indoor Air Quality Contaminant Control

Desiccant sorption is not restricted to water vapor. Both liquid and solid desiccants collect both water and large organic molecules at the same time (Hines et al. 1993). As a result, desiccant systems can be used to remove volatile organic compound (VOC) emissions from building air systems.

In addition to preventing growth of mold, mildew, and bacteria by keeping buildings dry, desiccant systems can supplement filters to remove bacteria from the air itself. This is particularly useful for hospitals, medical facilities, and related biomedical manufacturing facilities where airborne microorganisms can cause costly problems. The usefulness of certain liquid and solid desiccants in such systems stems from their ability to either kill microorganisms or avoid sustaining their growth (Battelle 1971; SUNY Buffalo School of Medicine 1988).

Testing

Many test procedures require dehumidification with sorption equipment. Frequently, other means of dehumidification may be used with sorbent units, but the low moisture content required can be obtained only by liquid or solid sorbents. Some typical testing applications are as follows:

- Wind tunnels
- Spectroscopy rooms
- Paper and textile testing
- Bacteriological and plant growth rooms
- Dry boxes
- Environmental rooms and chambers

3. DESICCANT DRYING AT ELEVATED PRESSURE

The same sorption principles that pertain to atmospheric dehumidification apply to drying high-pressure air and process or other gases. The sorbents described previously can be used with equal effectiveness.

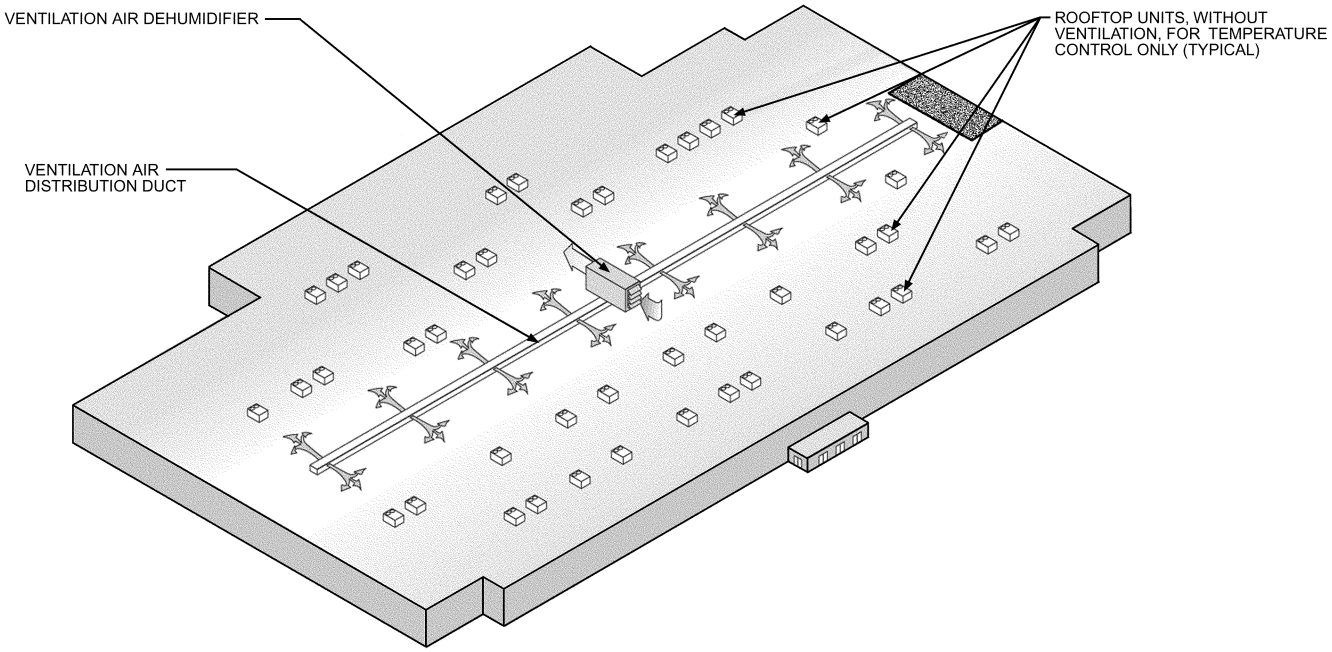


Fig. 22 Typical Rooftop Arrangement for Drying Ventilation Air Centrally, Removing Moisture Load from Cooling Units

(Harriman et al. 2001)

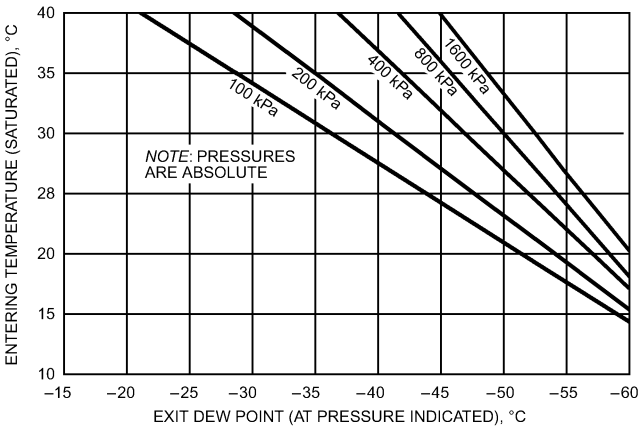


Fig. 23 Typical Performance Data for Solid Desiccant Dryers at Elevated Pressures

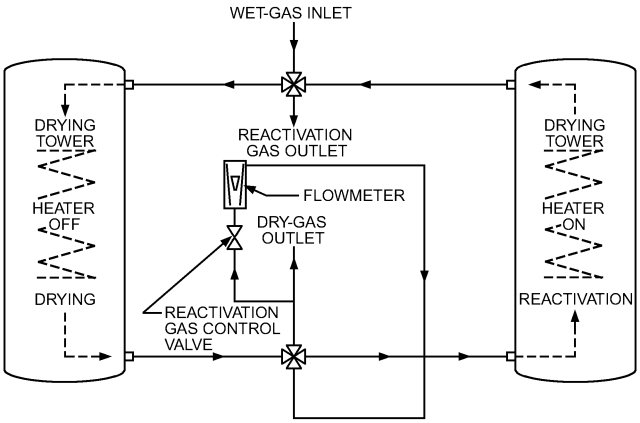


Fig. 24 Typical Adsorption Dryer for Elevated Pressures

3.1 EQUIPMENT TYPES

Absorption

Solid absorption systems use a calcium chloride desiccant, generally in a single-tower unit that requires periodic replacement of the desiccant that is dissolved by the absorbed moisture. Normally, inlet air or gas temperature does not exceed 32 to 38°C saturated. The rate of desiccant replacement is proportional to the moisture in the inlet process flow. A dew-point depression of 10 to 20 K at pressure can be obtained when the system is operated in the range of 15 to 38°C saturated entering temperature and 700 kPa (gage) operating pressure. At lower pressures, the ability to remove moisture decreases in proportion to absolute pressure. Such units do not require a power source for operation because the desiccant is not regenerated. However, additional desiccant must be added to the system periodically.

Adsorption

Drying with an adsorptive desiccant such as silica gel, activated alumina, or a molecular sieve usually incorporates regeneration equipment, so the desiccant can be reactivated and reused. These desiccants can be readily reactivated by heat, purging with dry gas, or both. Depending on the desiccant selected, dew-point performance expected is in the range of –40 to –75°C measured at the operating pressure with inlet conditions of 32 to 38°C saturated and 700 kPa (gage). Figure 23 shows typical performance using activated alumina or silica gel desiccant.

Equipment design may vary considerably in detail, but most basic adsorption units use twin-tower construction for continuous operation, with an internal or external heat source, with air or process gas as the reactivation purge for liberating moisture adsorbed previously. A single adsorbent bed may be used for intermittent drying requirements. Adsorption units are generally constructed in the same manner as atmospheric-pressure units, except that the vessels are suitable for the operating pressure. Units have been operated successfully at pressures as high as 40 MPa.

Prior compression or cooling (by water, brine, or refrigeration) to below the dew point of the gas to be dried reduces the total moisture load on the sorbent, permitting the use of smaller drying units. The cost of compression, cooling, or both must be balanced against the cost of a larger adsorption unit.

The many different dryer designs can be grouped into the following basic types:

Heat-reactivated, purge dryers. Normally operating on 4 h (or longer) adsorption periods, these dryers are generally designed with heaters embedded in the desiccant. They use a small portion of dried process gas as a purge to remove the moisture liberated during reactivation heating (see Figure 24).

Heatless dryers. These dryers operate on a short adsorption period (usually 60 to 300 s). Depressurizing gas in the desiccant tower lowers the vapor pressure, so adsorbed moisture is liberated from the desiccant and removed by a high purge rate of the dried process gas. Using an ejector reduces the purge gas requirements.

Convection dryers. These dryers usually operate on 4 h (or longer) adsorption periods and are designed with an external heater and cooler as the reactivation system. Some designs circulate reactivation process gas through the system by a blower; others divert some or all of the process gas flow through the reactivation system before adsorption. Both heating and cooling are by convection.

Radiation dryers. Also operating on 4 h (or longer) adsorption periods, radiation dryers are designed with an external heater and blower to force heated atmospheric air through the desiccant tower for reactivation. Desiccant tower cooling is by radiation to atmosphere.

3.2 APPLICATIONS

Material Preservation

Generally, materials in storage are preserved at atmospheric pressure, but a few materials are stored at elevated pressures, especially when the dried medium is an inert gas. These materials deteriorate when subjected to high relative humidity or oxygen content in the surrounding medium. Drying high-pressure air, subsequently reduced to 24 to 70 kPa (gage), has been used most effectively in pressurizing coaxial cables to eliminate electrical shorts caused by moisture infiltration. This same principle, at somewhat lower pressures, is also used in waveguides and radomes to prevent moisture film on the envelope.

Process Drying of Air and Other Gases

Drying instrument air to a dew point of –40°C, particularly where air lines are outdoors or exposed to temperatures below the dew point of air leaving the aftercooler, prevents condensation or freeze-up in instrument control lines.

To prevent condensation and freezing, it is necessary to dry plant air used for pneumatically operated valves, tools, and other equipment where piping is exposed to low ambient temperatures. Additionally, dry air prevents rusting of the air lines, which produces abrasive impurities, causing excessive wear on tools.

Industrial gases or fuels such as natural gas are dried. For example, fuels (including natural gas) are cleaned and dried before stor-

age underground to ensure that valves and transmission lines do not freeze from condensed moisture during extraordinarily cold weather, when the gas is most needed. Propane must also be clean and dry to prevent ice accumulation. Other gases, such as bottled oxygen, nitrogen, hydrogen, and acetylene, must have a high degree of dryness. In liquid oxygen and ozone manufacturing, air supplied to the process must be clean and dry.

Drying air or inert gas for conveying hygroscopic materials in a liquid or solid state ensures continuous, trouble-free plant operation. Normally, gases for this purpose are dried to a –40°C dew point. Purging and blanketing operations in the petrochemical industry depend on using dry inert gas for reducing problems such as explosive hazards and the reaction of chemicals with moisture or oxygen.

Equipment Testing

Dry, high-pressure air is used extensively for testing refrigeration condensing units to ensure tightness of components and to prevent moisture infiltration. Similarly, dry inert gas is used in testing copper tubing and coils to prevent corrosion or oxidation. Manufacture and assembly of solid-state circuits and other electronic components require exclusion of all moisture, and final testing in dry boxes must be carried out in moisture-free atmospheres. Simulation of dry high-altitude atmospheres for testing aircraft and missile components in wind tunnels requires extremely low dew-point conditions.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

ASHRAE Technical Committee 8.12 posts updated and additional information regarding desiccant equipment and systems on the committee's subsection of the ASHRAE web site at tc0812.ashraetcs.org.

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ASHRAE members can access *ASHRAE Journal* articles and ASHRAE research project final reports at technologyportal.ashrae.org. Articles and reports are also available for purchase by nonmembers in the online ASHRAE Bookstore at www.ashrae.org/bookstore.

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CHAPTER 25

MECHANICAL DEHUMIDIFIERS AND RELATED COMPONENTS

Mechanical Dehumidifiers 25.1
Controls and Sensors 25.10
Installation and Service Considerations 25.11
Wraparound Heat Exchangers 25.11

THE correct moisture level in the air is important for health and comfort. Controlling humidity and condensation is important to prevent moisture damage and mold or mildew development, thus protecting buildings and occupants, and preserving building contents. This chapter covers mechanical dehumidification using a cooling process only, including basic dehumidifier models (with moisture removal capacity of less than 1.4 kg/h) used for home basements and small storage areas, as well as larger sizes required for commercial applications.

Most mechanical dehumidifiers are used in applications where dew points of 7°C and above are maintained. Specialized mechanical dehumidification equipment may achieve as low as a 2°C dew point at a lower moisture removal rate. For applications requiring low dew points and for other methods of dehumidification, see Chapter 24.

Commercial applications for mechanical dehumidifiers include the following:

- Dedicated outdoor air systems
- Controlled environment agriculture
- Indoor swimming pools
- Makeup air treatment
- Ice rinks
- Dry storage
- Schools
- Hospitals
- Office buildings
- Museums, libraries, and archives
- Restaurants
- Hotels and motels
- Assisted living facilities
- Supermarkets
- Manufacturing plants and processes
- Water making
- Industrial drying

In addition, an air-to-air heat exchanger (e.g., heat pipe, coil runaround loop, fixed-plate heat exchanger, rotary heat exchanger) may be used to enhance moisture removal by a mechanical dehumidifier or air conditioner. The section on wraparound heat exchangers discusses how dehumidification processes can be improved by using such a device. Other uses of air-to-air heat exchangers are covered in Chapter 26.

1. MECHANICAL DEHUMIDIFIERS

Mechanical dehumidifiers remove moisture by passing air over a surface that has been cooled below the air's dew point. This cold surface may be the exterior of a chilled-water coil or a direct-expansion refrigerant coil. To prevent overcooling the space (and avoid the need to add heat energy from another source), a mechanical dehumidifier also usually has means to reheat the air, normally using recovered and recycled energy (e.g., recovering heat from hot refrigerant vapor in the refrigeration circuit) or, in the case of a chilled-water dehumidifying system, using wrap around heat exchangers to absorb heat energy from incoming air then passively transferring it around the cooling coil into the leaving air). Using external energy input for reheat is wasteful and is prohibited or limited in many countries (see ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1).

A mechanical dehumidifier differs from a typical off-the-shelf air conditioner in that the dehumidifier usually has a much lower sensible heat ratio (SHR). The dehumidifier starts the compressor on a call for dehumidification, whereas an air conditioner starts the compressor on a call for sensible cooling. Typically, a room dehumidifier has an SHR of 0.6 or less, compared to a standard air-conditioning system of 0.8 SHR. Dehumidifiers must also allow condensation from the cooling coil to drain easily from the coils. They may need air velocities over the cooling coil lower than those for a typical air conditioner, to improve moisture runoff and minimize carryover of condensed moisture.

In addition, the need to introduce code-mandated ventilation air may require that outdoor air be treated to avoid introducing excessive moisture. Basic strategies include precooling outdoor air entering the air-conditioning evaporator coil, or providing a separate system to provide properly conditioned outdoor air. For some low-dew-point (below 7°C) applications, mechanical dehumidification may be used as the first stage, with desiccant dehumidification for the final stage to maximize efficiency and minimize installed cost.

Although the main purpose of a mechanical dehumidifier is to remove moisture from the air, many features can be incorporated for various applications, such as

- Dehumidifying and cooling (no reheat)
- Dehumidifying with partial reheat (leaving dry-bulb temperature is cooler than with a dehumidifier with full reheat)
- Dehumidifying with full reheat
- Dehumidifying with heat recovery to various heat sinks
- Dehumidification capacity modulation
- Reheat capacity modulation
- Ventilation air introduction
- Auxiliary space or water heating

Often, mechanical dehumidifiers can be incorporated in a system to use waste heat from mechanical cooling (e.g., heat rejection to a swimming pool, whirlpool, domestic hot water, heat pump loop, chilled-water loop, or remote air-cooled condenser).

Outdoor dehumidifiers should be protected against internal moisture condensation when winter conditions are severe, because of the higher dew-point temperature of air circulating in the unit.

Psychrometrics of Dehumidification

Figures 1 and 2 show the process of air moving over the dehumidifying coil and being reheated. Many manufacturers size the dehumidifying coil for only part of the unit total airflow. This allows them to introduce outdoor air after the dehumidifying coil and allows more unit airflow for the condenser reheat coil to maintain

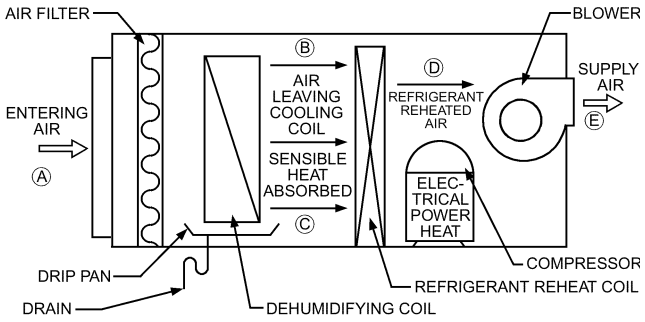

Fig. 1 Dehumidification Process Points

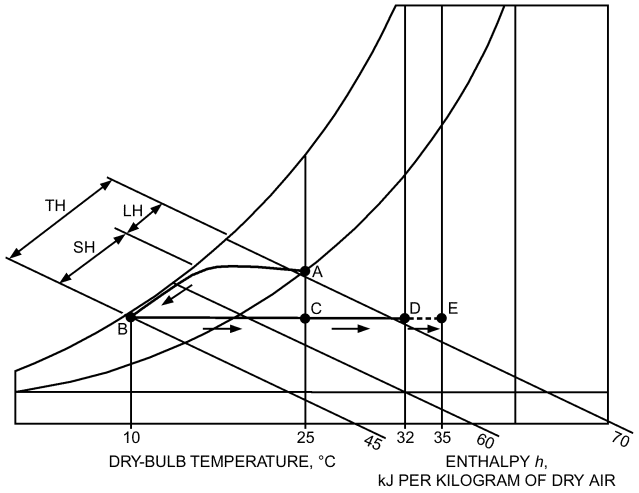

Fig. 2 Psychrometric Diagram of Typical Dehumidification Process

proper system refrigeration pressures when rejecting refrigerant heat to the airstream. Figures 3 and 4 show a bypass air process.

In Figures 1 and 2, air enters the dehumidifying coil at point A. The dehumidifying coil removes sensible heat (SH) and latent heat (LH) from the airstream. The dehumidified, cooled air leaves the coil at its saturation temperature at point B. The total heat removed (TH) is the net cooling capacity of the system.

In reheating, the refrigerant (hot gas) rejects heat it has obtained from multiple sources. Sensible heat absorbed in the air-cooling process is rejected to air leaving the cooling coil. This air is at point C, which is the same dry-bulb temperature as the entering air minus the moisture content. This heat is also rejected into the airstream, raising the air temperature to point D. Also, nearly all electric power required to drive the refrigeration cycle is converted to heat. This portion of heat rejection raises the air leaving temperature to point E.

This process assumes that all heat is rejected by the refrigerant reheat coil. Depending on refrigerant system complexity, any part of the total heat rejection can be diverted to other heat exchangers (condensers/desuperheaters).

Dehumidifier supply air temperatures can be controlled between 10 and 35°C. However, system design should not rely on a mechanical dehumidifier as a dependable heat source for space heating, because heat is only available when the unit is operating.

In Figures 3 and 4, air enters the dehumidifying coil at point A. The dehumidifying coil removes sensible heat (SH) and latent heat (LH) from the airstream. The dehumidified, cooled air leaves the coil at its saturation temperature at point B. The total heat removed (TH) is the net cooling capacity of the system.

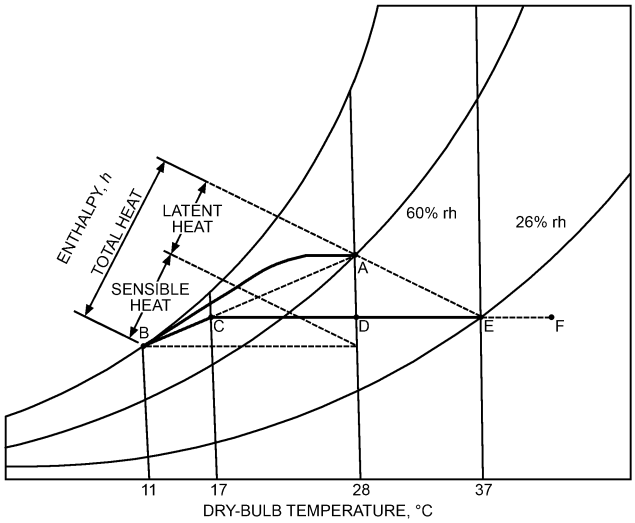

Fig. 3 Psychrometric Diagram of Typical Dehumidification Process with Bypass Air

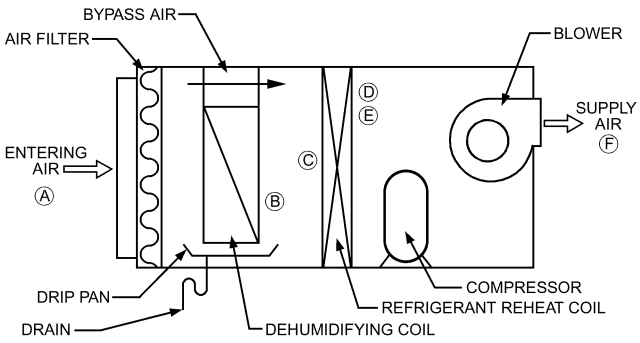

Fig. 4 Dehumidification Process Points with Bypass Air

In Figure 3, the air at B mixes with the bypass air to get to point C. In reheating, the refrigerant (hot gas) rejects heat it has obtained from three sources. First, sensible heat absorbed in the air-cooling process is rejected to air leaving the cooling coil. This air is at point D, which is the same dry-bulb temperature as the entering air minus the moisture content. Next, the latent heat removal that causes the moisture to condense also adds heat to the hot refrigerant gas. This heat is also rejected into the airstream, raising the air temperature to point E. Finally, nearly all electric power required to drive the refrigeration cycle is converted to heat. This portion of heat rejection raises the air's leaving temperature to point F.

This process assumes that all heat is rejected by the refrigerant reheat coil. Depending on refrigerant system complexity, any part of the total heat rejection can be diverted to other heat exchangers (condensers/desuperheaters).

Dehumidifier supply air temperatures can be controlled between 18 and 40°C. However, system design should not rely on a mechanical dehumidifier as a dependable heat source for space heating, because heat is only available when the unit is operating.

Residential Dehumidifiers

Portable Dehumidifiers. These are smaller (usually less than 3.5 kW), simpler versions of commercial dehumidifiers. They are self-contained and easily movable. They are designed to be used in localized areas, such as basements or other high-moisture areas.

As shown in Figure 5, a single fan draws humid room air through the cold coil, removing moisture that either drains into the water receptacle or passes through the cabinet into some other means of disposal. The cooled air passes through the condenser, reheating the air.

Portable dehumidifiers ordinarily maintain satisfactory humidity levels in an enclosed space when the airflow rate and unit placement move the entire air volume of the space through the dehumidifier once an hour.

Design and Construction. Portable dehumidifiers use hermetic motor-compressors; the refrigerant condenser is usually conventional finned tube. Refrigerant flow is usually controlled by a capillary tube, although some high-capacity dehumidifiers use an expansion valve. A propeller fan moves air through the unit at typical airflows of 70 to 120 L/s.

The refrigerated surface (evaporator) is usually a bare-tube coil, although finned-tube coils can be used if they are spaced to allow rapid runoff of water droplets. Vertically disposed bare-tube coils tend to collect smaller drops of water, promote quicker runoff, and result in less condensate reevaporation compared to finned-tube or horizontally arranged bare-tube coils. Continuous bare-tube coils, wound in a flat circular spiral (sometimes with two coil layers) and mounted with the flat dimension of the coil in the vertical plane, are a good design compromise because they have most of the advantages of the vertical bare-tube coil.

Evaporators are protected against corrosion by finishes such as waxing, painting, or anodizing (on aluminum). Waxing reduces the wetting effect that promotes condensate formation; however, tests on waxed versus nonwaxed evaporator surfaces show negligible loss of capacity. Thin paint films do not have an appreciable effect on capacity.

Removable water receptacles, provided with most dehumidifiers, hold 7.5 to 11 L and are usually made of plastic to withstand corrosion. Easy removal and handling without spillage are important. Most dehumidifiers also provide either a means of attaching a flexible hose to the water receptacle or a fitting provided specially for that purpose, allowing direct gravity drainage to another means of disposal external to the cabinet.

An adjustable humidistat (30 to 80%) automatically cycles the unit to maintain a preselected relative humidity. The humidistat may also provide a detent setting for continuous operation. Some models also include a sensing and switching device that automatically turns the unit off when the water receptacle is full.

Dehumidifiers are designed to provide optimum performance at standard rating conditions of 27°C db room temperature and 60% rh. When the room is less than 18°C db and 60% rh, the evaporator may freeze. This effect is especially noticeable on units with a capillary tube.

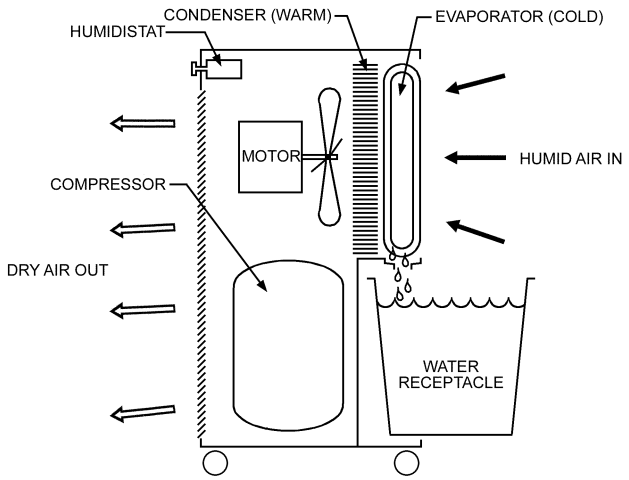

Fig. 5 Typical Portable Dehumidifier

Some dehumidifiers are equipped with defrost controls that cycle the compressor off under frosting conditions. This control is generally a bimetal thermostat attached to the evaporator tubing, allowing dehumidification to continue at a reduced rate when frosting conditions exist. The humidistat can sometimes be adjusted to a higher relative humidity setting, which reduces the number and duration of running cycles and allows satisfactory operation at low-load conditions. Often, especially in the late fall and early spring, supplemental heat must be provided from other sources to maintain above-frosting temperatures in the space.

Capacity and Performance Rating. Portable dehumidifiers are available with moisture removal capacities of 5 to 30 L per 24 h, and are operable from ordinary household electrical outlets (115 or 230 V, single-phase, 60 Hz). Input varies from 200 to 800 W, depending on the output capacity rating.

AHAM *Standard* DH-1 establishes a uniform procedure for determining the rated capacity of dehumidifiers under specified test conditions and establishes other recommended performance characteristics. An industry certification program sponsored by AHAM covers the great majority of portable dehumidifiers and certifies dehumidification capacity.

The U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) qualifies dehumidifiers to carry its ENERGY STAR® label if they remove the same amount of moisture as similarly sized standard units, but use at least 10% less energy. The EPA's ENERGY STAR website provides additional information on qualifying products (EPA 2020).

Whole-House Dehumidifiers. Whole-house dehumidifiers have higher moisture removal capacity than portable dehumidifiers. Blowers in whole-house dehumidifiers are typically more powerful because they draw air through the unit at higher external static pressures as compared to portable dehumidifiers. The design allows for connection of ductwork to the unit's inlet and outlet. Moist air is typically drawn from either the return plenum of the HVAC system ductwork (Figure 6) or from a centrally located register. The air is dehumidified and then discharged into the supply ductwork of the HVAC system for distribution. To prevent reevaporation of moisture from the HVAC system evaporator coil, the dry air enters the system downstream of the coil.

Whole-house dehumidifiers typically integrate controls to allow operation of the HVAC system blower while dehumidifying the air; this allows the dry air to be distributed throughout the home. Some dehumidifiers are equipped with controls to bring in outdoor air, which can then be run through the dehumidifier before being distributed to the rest of the home. Sensors are typically located inside the dehumidifier to measure the temperature and relative humidity of air passing through the unit as opposed to the surrounding air. Controls on some models may provide for installation of a remote humidistat or humidity sensor. Drain tubing must typically be installed on the dehumidifier and routed to the nearest floor drain. Most models include an internal condensate overflow switch or provide for the installation of a field-installed overflow switch that will turn the unit off if it overflows.

Units are typically sheltered from the elements and should not be installed in locations that can experience freezing temperatures. Whole-house dehumidifiers are typically located near the HVAC system for convenient access to the supply and return plenums and to drains. Systems may be installed in basements, closets, crawlspaces, or attics, so dehumidifier cabinets are typically insulated. When units are installed over a finished area, drain pans are commonly installed under the unit.

Codes. Domestic dehumidifiers are designed to meet the safety requirements of UL *Standard* 474, *Canadian Electrical Code*, and ASHRAE *Standard* 15. UL-listed and CSA-approved equipment have a label or data plate indicating approval. UL also publishes the

Electrical Appliance and Utilization Equipment Directory, which covers this type of appliance.

General-Purpose Dehumidifiers

Basic components of general-purpose dehumidifiers are shown in Figure 7. An air filter is required to protect the evaporator. Dehumidifying coils, because of their depth and thoroughly wetted surfaces, are excellent dust collectors and not as easily cleanable as much thinner air-conditioning evaporator coils. However, the large amount of condensate has a self-cleaning effect. A bypass damper at the evaporator coil allows airflow adjustments for the evaporator without decreasing airflow for the reheat coil. Dehumidifying and reheat coils may operate at different airflows.

The compressor may be isolated from the airstream or located in it. Locating the compressor in the airstream may make service more difficult, but this arrangement allows heat lost through the compressor casing to be provided to the conditioned space while reducing the size of the enclosure. During the cooling season, this compressor location reduces the unit's sensible cooling capacity.

Code-required outdoor air may be introduced between the evaporator and reheat coil. The amount of outdoor air should be controlled to not adversely affect the refrigeration system's operation.

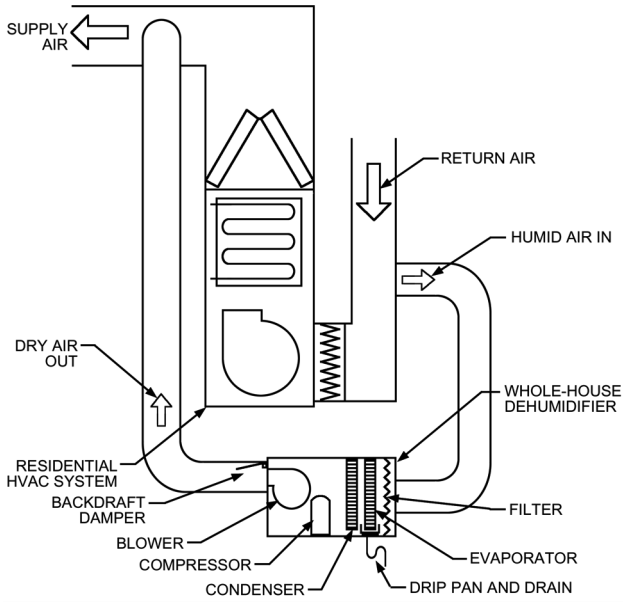

Fig. 6 Typical Whole-House Dehumidifier Installation

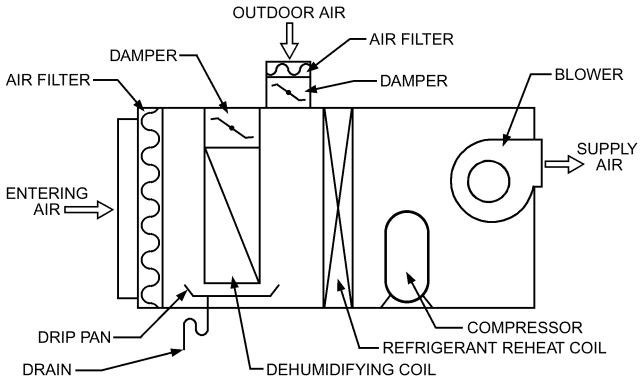

Fig. 7 Typical General-Purpose Dehumidifier

Preheating outdoor air may be required in colder climates. Use caution when introducing outdoor air before the evaporator coil. Some applications (e.g., indoor swimming pools) have a constant moisture load year round. The dehumidifier's performance is based on the conditions of the air moving across the evaporator coil. Mixing outdoor air with space return air before the evaporator coil changes the dehumidifier's performance to latent removal, which may be less than the space load and result in the inability to maintain the original design conditions. The unit's latent capacity can be significantly reduced when outdoor air is introduced before the evaporator coil.

Computerized controls can sense return air temperature and relative humidity. Remote wall-mounted sensors are also available. More sophisticated controls are desirable to regulate dew-point temperature and maintain the desired relative humidity in the space.

General Considerations. Before considering installation of any type of dehumidification equipment, all latent loads should be identified and quantified. In many cases, this might lead to decisions that reduce the latent load. For example, a storage facility that does not have an adequate vapor retarder in the building envelope should be retrofitted before attempting to calculate the amount of moisture migration through the structure. The same approach should be taken to reduce the amount of uncontrolled air infiltration.

Consider covering large water surfaces, such as vats, and/or providing a local exhaust hood to evacuate concentrated water vapor from where it is generated. Although these corrections seem to add cost to a project, the resulting reduced size of the dehumidifier and its lower operating cost often result in an attractive financial payback.

Other special considerations include the following:

- **High volumes of outdoor air.** A project may start out as suitable for a general-purpose dehumidifier. However, once outdoor air requirements are quantified to compensate for exhaust and to pressurize the facility, a general-purpose dehumidifier may no longer be applicable. The maximum acceptable portion of outdoor air for general-purpose dehumidifiers is limited, and depends on climatic conditions and the desired indoor conditions to be maintained. As a general rule, when outdoor air requirements exceed 20% of the dehumidifier's total airflow, the manufacturer should be consulted to determine whether the equipment is suitable for the application. In many cases, a direct-exchange (DX) dedicated outdoor air system unit should be considered instead.
- **Low-return-air-temperature applications.** When the return air temperature is below 18°C, consult the dehumidifier manufacturer to determine whether the equipment is suitable for the application. Recognize that defrost control might be required.

DX Dedicated Outdoor Air System (DOAS) Units

A **DX dedicated outdoor air system (DX-DOAS)** unit is used to separately condition outdoor air brought into the building for ventilation or to replace air that is being exhausted. (As such, select a DX-DOAS unit based on its latent dehumidification capacity, not necessarily on its total air-conditioning capacity.) This conditioned outdoor air is then delivered either directly to each occupied space, to small HVAC units located in or near the space, or to a central air handler serving the spaces. Meanwhile, the local or central HVAC equipment is used to maintain space temperature. Treating outdoor air separately from recirculated return air makes it more straightforward to verify sufficient ventilation airflow and enables humidity control in the occupied spaces. Decoupling the latent load from the sensible using a DX-DOAS can make both the dehumidifier and sensible cooling equipment more efficient.

DX-DOAS units use a vapor compression refrigeration cycle as part of the system to cool the air below its dew point and condense the moisture on a dehumidifying coil.

AHRI *Standard* 921 establishes requirements for the testing and rating of moisture removal capacity and moisture removal effi-

ciency of DX-DOAS units. ASHRAE *Standard* 198 prescribes test methods for rating DX-DOAS units.

DX-DOAS units may require simultaneous heat rejection to the reheat coil and/or another condenser (air- or water-cooled), because it may not always be possible or warranted in the application to reject the total heat of rejection from the dehumidifying coil to the conditioned airstream. A rainproof air intake and cooling capacity modulation (or staging) are important. With constantly changing weather conditions, even throughout the day, compressor capacity must be adjusted to prevent coil freeze-ups. Basic components are shown in Figure 8.

Auxiliary heating may be required for year-round operation in some climates. Water- and steam-heating coils should have freeze protection features. When using indirect-fired gas heaters, the combustion chamber should be resistant to condensation.

DX-DOAS units may be interfaced with a building automation system (BAS) to control the unit's on/off status and operating mode, because most spaces do not require continuous ventilation or replacement air. Air exhaust systems must also be synchronized with the DX-DOAS unit to maintain proper building pressurization.

The inclusion of exhaust air energy recovery within DX-DOAS units provides the opportunity to transfer energy between the two airstreams. A typical arrangement is shown in Figure 9.

For more information on DOAS, see Chapter 51.

Indoor Swimming Pool Dehumidifiers

Indoor pools (natatoriums) are an efficient application for mechanical dehumidifiers. Humidity control is required 24 h a day, year-round. Dehumidifiers are available as single- and double-blower units (see Figures 10 to 13). AHRI *Standard* 911 establishes requirements for testing and rating moisture removal capacity and moisture removal efficiency of indoor pool dehumidifiers. ASHRAE *Standard* 190 prescribes test methods for rating these units.

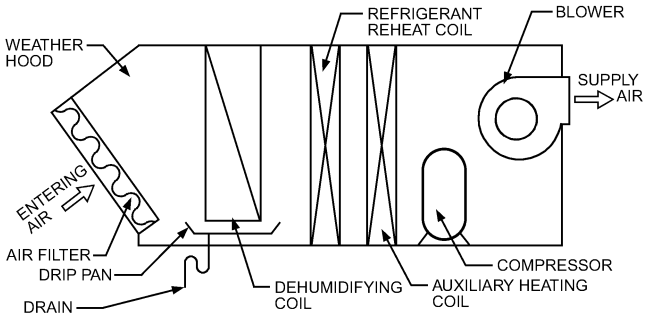

Fig. 8 DX-DOAS Unit

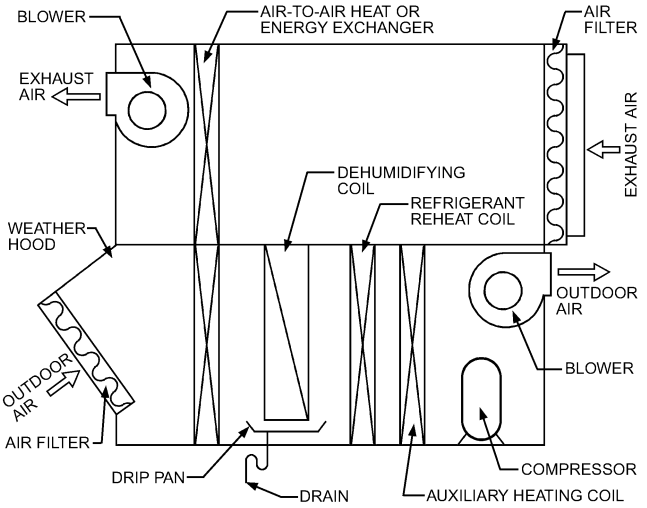

Fig. 9 DX-DOAS Unit with Exhaust Air Heat/Energy

The latent heat (LH) from dehumidification (see Figure 2) comes nearly exclusively from pool water (excluding humidity from makeup air and latent heat from large spectator areas). Loss of evaporation heat cools the pool water. By returning evaporation heat losses to the pool water, the sensible heat between points C and D of Figure 2 is not rejected into the supply air, which can reduce supply air temperature by approximately 8 K. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 requires that heated pools be provided with a vapor-retardant pool cover unless 60% of their energy for heating is site recovered. Use of compressor waste heat for pool water heating may satisfy this requirement.

Energy Considerations. The pool water temperature, space temperature, and relative humidity conditions maintained at a facility directly affect occupant comfort, dehumidifier size, and operating costs. It is important that the design engineer understand the effects of changes to these conditions to properly establish realistic operating conditions for a given project. Operating temperatures can change dramatically, depending on the type of pool being designed. See Table 2 in Chapter 6 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for additional information.

The peak dehumidification load and peak energy conditions may not be concurrent in a natatorium. The peak dehumidification load generally occurs on a summer design day where the latent load from ventilation air is at its peak. The peak energy condition often is in the winter, when cold, dry ventilation air is a significant heating load and dehumidification credit to the space. In addition to extra heating costs, introducing more outdoor air than required by code in winter increases operating costs by driving space relative humidity levels down. This increases pool water evaporation and, consequently, pool water heating, makeup water, and pool chemical costs. Low humidity levels also increase bather discomfort through the evaporation effect across the surface of bathers' skin, causing a chilling effect on leaving the pool.

Fan energy can be a significant portion of the total energy consumed by a natatorium dehumidifier because the supply air fan operates constantly and delivers relatively high amounts of air.

Many dehumidifiers have exhaust fans to maintain the natatorium at a negative pressure. This exhaust air is energy rich, and heat recovery should be considered. Dehumidifiers are available with heat recovery such as heat pipes, glycol-runaround loops, compressorized heat pumps, and plate heat exchangers that transfer heat from the energy-rich exhaust air to cold incoming ventilation air (see Chapter 26).

Condensation. Note that the space dew point in most pools is above 17°C. Even when space conditions are properly maintained, there is still a significantly higher chance, compared to traditional conditioned spaces, that condensation might occur in the space or within the HVAC system. Condensation is possible in winter or summer.

Most codes have adopted ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 to determine the amount of outdoor air required for acceptable indoor air quality. Introducing outdoor air that is cooler than the room dew-point temperature could lead to condensation. This is especially important in areas that experience cold winters. If condensation might occur, preheating the outdoor air is required.

Most dehumidifiers have a cooling mode. The units are generally designed to ensure supply air to the space is warmer than the space dew point. When adding additional cooling capacity to a dehumidifier, summer condensation is a concern if supply air could be cooled below the dew point of either the outdoor air or the space.

Designers are encouraged to verify that all necessary measures to avoid condensation have been taken, especially when modifying or customizing standard products from manufacturers. Discharge air must always be supplied at a temperature higher than the room dew-point temperature. Similarly, blended airstreams must not be allowed to result in temperatures cooler than the space dew point.

Single-blower pool dehumidifiers (Figure 10) are similar to general-purpose dehumidifiers (see Figure 4), with the following exceptions:

- Recovered heat from the refrigeration circuit can be used to provide heating to one or more pools or for domestic water preheat.
- All components in the airstream must be corrosion-resistant to chloramine-laden air. Electrical panels must be fully isolated from the chloramine-laden airstream.
- The pool water heater must be resistant to chlorinated water.
- Cross-contamination prevention features in the pool water heater are not required, but should be considered to prevent introducing refrigerant oil to the pool water if a breach occurred.
- Polyol ester (POE) refrigerant oil will damage polyvinyl chloride (PVC) piping.

Figure 11 shows a double-blower pool dehumidifier with economizer dampers and a full-sized return fan located upstream of the evaporator coil. This configuration can provide up to 100% makeup air to maintain humidity levels, which can be attractive when the outdoor dew point is below the required indoor dew point during mild weather, or in climates when enough hours of dry- and wet-bulb conditions are below the level to be maintained. Preheating outdoor air may be required to prevent condensation inside the mixing box. Also, this configuration does not recover energy from the warm, moist exhaust air. During dehumidifying coil operation, the amount of makeup and exhaust air is limited by outdoor conditions, especially during the heating season. Cold makeup air may lower the mixed-air temperature to the point where the dehumidifying coil cannot extract any moisture. Be careful during economizer operation to not introduce more outdoor air than required by code, so as not to lower the space humidity below design levels, as discussed in the section on Energy Considerations.

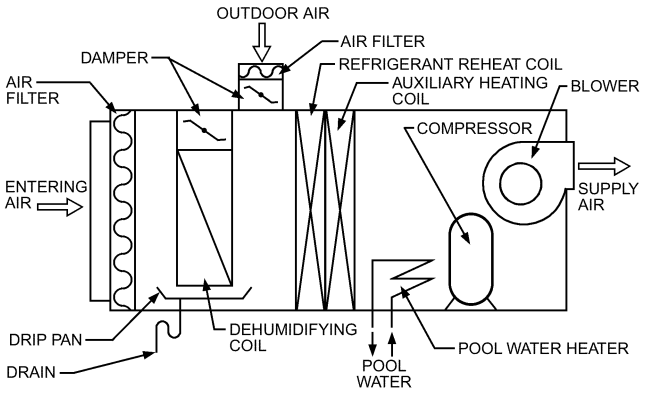

Fig. 10 Typical Single-Blower Pool Dehumidifier

In some regions, it is economically attractive to remove moisture from the exhaust air to recover its latent heat. In this case, the dehumidifying coil is installed in the return air section. Figure 12 shows a double-blower pool dehumidifier with economizer dampers and return fan located downstream of the evaporator coil. A damper system can also be incorporated to exhaust before the evaporator coil during colder conditions and after the evaporator during warmer conditions. This configuration recovers energy from the warm, moist exhaust air; however, exhausting air from downstream of the evaporator coil also reduces the unit's sensible capacity by the amount of the exhaust air. The ratio of return air to exhaust air must be considered to determine the unit's capacity to remove moisture from the conditioned space.

Figure 13 shows a different unit configuration that addresses concerns related to blower energy use during the various operating modes. This unit can operate with the supply blower only, or with the addition of one or two exhaust blowers.

Most manufacturers also offer some means of air-to-air heat recovery between the exhaust and makeup airstreams (see Chapter 26). During cold weather, this arrangement preheats entering makeup air with heat recovered from the exhaust airstream. Latent heat recovery may not be practical, however, because it transfers moisture to the entering air, thus possibly increasing dehumidification requirements.

Control systems should be compatible with building automation systems; however, the BAS must not disable dehumidifier operation because indoor pools always need some dehumidification, regardless of occupancy, and require specialized control sequences.

General Considerations. The primary function of an indoor swimming pool dehumidifier is to maintain the space dew-point temperature at the design level year round and to provide adequate air circulation to comply with minimum air change rates.

For more information on indoor swimming pool (natatorium) applications, see Chapter 6 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Types of Equipment. Indoor swimming pool dehumidifiers are available in single- and double-blower configurations (see Figures 10 to 13). Heat from the refrigeration circuit can be (1) used to reheat supply air, (2) used to heat pool water, or (3) rejected to the

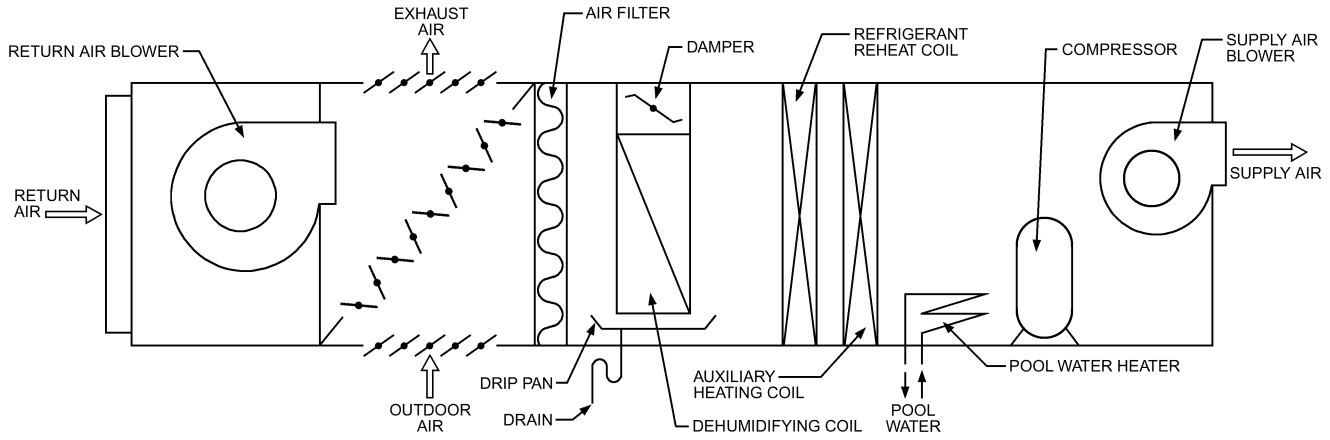

Fig. 11 Typical Double-Blower Pool Dehumidifier with DX Coil in Supply Air Section

outdoors by an optional air- or water-cooled condenser. Equipment configurations are available to use the heat for any combination of these three purposes.

The equipment can be located indoors or outdoors, and may be manufactured as a single package or as a split system with a remote condenser. Avoiding remote condensers with long refrigerant lines reduces refrigerant charge. Indoor, air-cooled condensers are typically equipped with a blower-type fan suitable for duct connections. An optional economizer allows for introduction of up to 100% of outdoor air (turning off the compressors) when conditions are appropriate.

When selecting a dehumidifier for an indoor swimming pool application, several questions need to be addressed to ensure that the dehumidifier can maintain the space conditions:

- In what mode of operation is the dehumidifier rated?
- Does the rating include ventilation air, and what effect, if any, does it have on dehumidifier performance?
- Does the unit include exhaust air, and what effect, if any, does it have on dehumidifier performance?
- Does the cost of running a second fan offset the energy saved by the economizer?
- Will the dehumidifier maintain the desired space conditions during all modes of operation?

Ice Rink Dehumidifiers

Design for ice rink dehumidifiers is similar to that of general-purpose dehumidifiers (see Figure 4). However, because of the lower temperatures, airflow and dehumidifying and reheat coils are selected in accordance with the following conditions:

- The dehumidifying coil may or may not have an air bypass, depending on the location of makeup air intake and/or coil selection.
- The dehumidifying coil may have means to defrost or to prevent frost formation.
- Makeup air treatment is limited.

For large spectator areas, special makeup air dehumidifiers may be required.

General Considerations. For community ice rinks with small spectator areas (or none), it is customary to install two small dehumidifiers over the dasher boards in a diagonal arrangement, 3.7 to 4.6 m above the ice surface (Figure 14). Take care that discharge air from dehumidifiers is not directed toward the ice surface. Forced airflow at any temperature may damage the ice surface. Ice rinks with large spectator areas have different requirements.

The spectator area is typically maintained at 21°C. To limit moisture migration to the ice sheet, space conditions must be maintained at 50% rh or less. The resulting dew-point temperature is then 10°C or less. The air temperature over the ice sheet in the dasher boards, however, is approximately 3 K lower than the air in the spectator area. With an air temperature of 18°C and a dew-point temperature

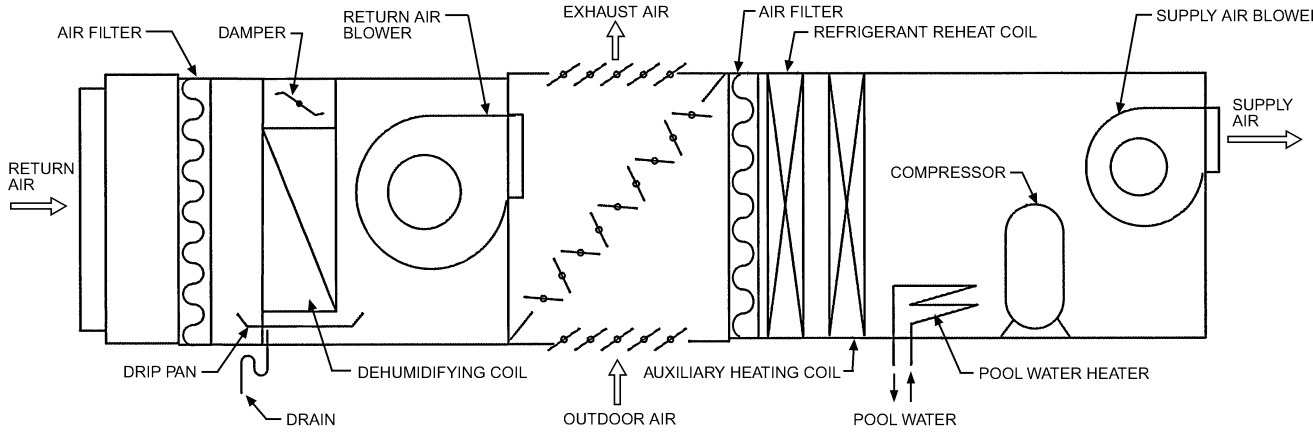

Fig. 12 Typical Double-Blower Pool Dehumidifier with DX Coil in Return Air Section

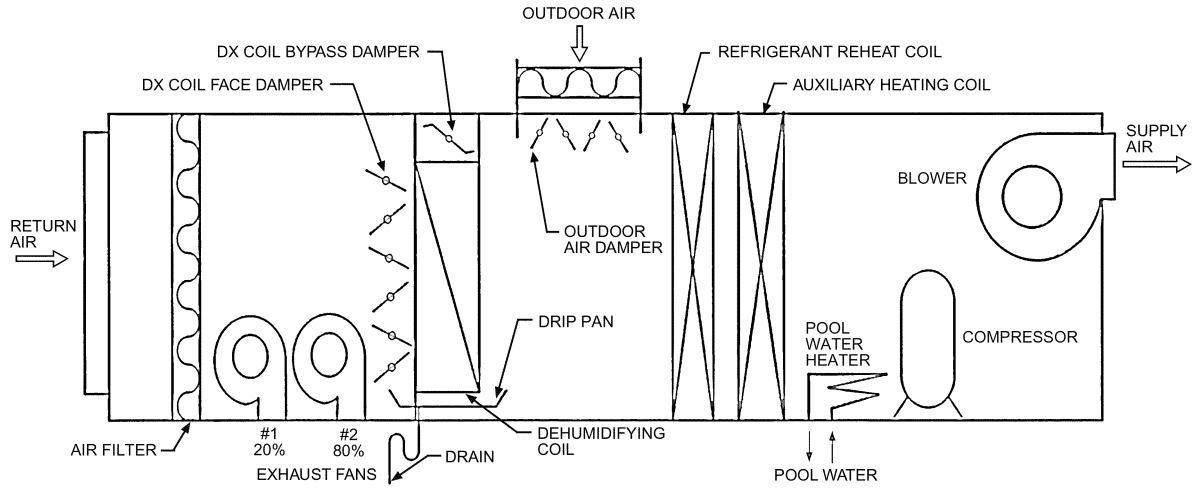

Fig. 13 Supply Blower and Double Exhaust Blower Pool Dehumidifier

of 10°C or less, fog over the ice sheet cannot develop. As a general rule, mechanical ice rink dehumidifiers are most effective for condensation and fog control when dry-bulb space temperature is at least 8 K above the dew point. For additional fog and condensation prevention methods, see Chapter 44 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

Industrial Dehumidifiers

Industrial products and surfaces can sweat, causing corrosion, dimensional distortions, and other deterioration from excess humidity in the air. In some cases, this humidity is caused by leakage or infiltration; in other cases, it may be from indoor storage or processes. Normal air conditioning is not always adequate to control excess humidity, leading to material or structural damages and cool but damp working conditions. Industrial dehumidifiers use direct-expansion refrigeration coils to remove moisture and thus lower the supply air dew point to

- Prevent undesirable condensing or sweating on products and surfaces
- Improve product/process quality
- Help reduce building repair and maintenance costs
- Provide a comfortably dry working environment (max. 60% rh)
- Minimize biological pollutants such as mold spores

Some mechanical dehumidifiers may also contribute to space heating and/or cooling, recover heat energy for processes, and/or recover water for allowable purposes.

Sources of Humidity. Indoor air quality is affected by several key factors, which vary in importance depending on the location of the building and on the activity for which a building is designed. Relative humidity is usually a critical air quality factor, with high indoor relative humidity resulting from the following sources of moisture:

- Increased quantities of humid outdoor air brought in to improve air quality
- Openings, infiltration and permeation
- Moisture produced by occupants
- Moisture released by products or processes

Moisture migrates from areas of high vapor pressure to areas of low vapor pressure. In the summer, when the outdoor air is warm and humid, moisture can find a path to the interior of a cooler or drier structure. This could be from openings in the building such as doors, infiltration through cracks and poorly sealed joints, or permeation in the case of low-quality or nonexistent vapor retarders. In many instances, the primary source of humidity is from outdoor air purposely brought into the structure to meet air quality standards, or to replace air being exhausted because of contamination.

Occupants contribute to the moisture load through respiration and perspiration; amounts depend on the number of people and their activities. A worker involved in heavy lifting can generate seven times the moisture of a co-worker seated at rest. In agricultural or laboratory structures, animals also produce a moisture load.

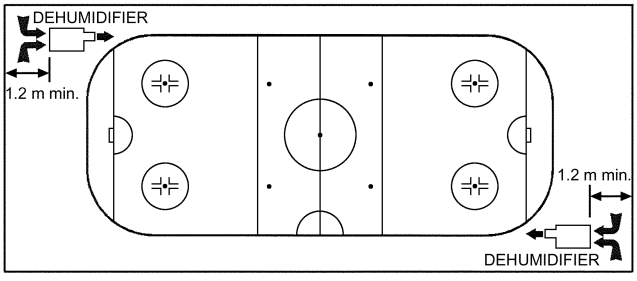

Fig. 14 Typical Installation of Ice Rink Dehumidifiers

Indoor materials or processes may give off moisture. Storing or cooking fruits, vegetables, or other foodstuffs may release moisture indoors. The presence of open tanks of water or the storing or handling of wet materials, such as wood, may also release moisture indoors.

Moisture dissolved in indoor air will condense onto any surface that is at a temperature lower than the room air's dew-point temperature. This can lead to quality and productivity problems or even to damage to the building and plant equipment. Rust and corrosion can affect metal surfaces, electrical controls and contacts, etc., which can lead to increased costs and even to potentially hazardous conditions.

For typical conditions (temperatures and relative humidities) of industrial applications, see Table 1 of Chapter 15 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Dehumidifiers for Controlled Environment Agriculture (CEA)

If the main conditioning system is not selected to handle the high dehumidification load of a grow or drying space, the engineer may use a combination of a primary cooling air-handling system combined with in-room or ducted dehumidifiers to support the main cooling system for the water load in these rooms. Dehumidifiers for controlled environment agriculture share many of the characteristics of general-purpose dehumidifiers (see Figures 4 and 7), but may have a few additional design considerations because of the specialized nature of their application:

- Dehumidifiers can be the primary total environmental control or used in conjunction with a primary cooling system.
  - Care must be taken in the engineering calculations of load to ensure that the combined systems can address the loads for the entire duration of the plant's life cycle, day and night, and all associated transition periods.
  - The watering rate can vary widely between growing recipes; a thorough discussion with the grower must be had to understand the water and lighting loads for each stage of life of the plant when that plant enters and leaves that room.
  - The capacity of dehumidifiers is typically reported on a litres-per-day rate. Careful consideration of the calculations should be undertaken for the hourly water removal rate, calculated at the actual room conditions at the time and additional sensible heat component added by the dehumidification units.
- Air distribution is of critical importance in grow rooms, especially when using unitary dehumidification units with ducted primary conditioning systems. Dehumidification outlets provide warm or hot very dry air, and if that air is directed at the plants in either grow rooms or drying rooms, the plants will realize localized microclimates.
  - In a grow room, this causes these plants to dry out more quickly. In some cases this will cause these plants to grow faster than the rest of the room, eventually running short of water, exposing them to risk of failure. Should the grower increase the amount of watering, then the balance of plants will be exposed to overwatering, and cause failure as well.
  - In drying rooms, product can be damaged from drying too quickly or by over-drying causing damage to the plant material and decreasing product quality.
- Dehumidifiers for growing rooms in CEA are typically much larger than general-purpose or portable dehumidifiers, with 240 to 2300 L/day (10 to 90 kg/h) capacities
  - Great care must be taken with respect to placement with the maintenance of these units in mind. The larger dehumidification systems can weigh hundreds of kilograms and require gantries or trolleys to move when they require replacement.

  - Dehumidifiers of this type are still under severe duty loading and will have abbreviated service lives when compared to dehumidifiers in more conventional applications. As such, maintenance access and ease of unit "swapping" is crucial to the successful future operation of these systems.
  - Keep in mind that replacement of units is preferable upon component failure to reduce the downtime impact on the rooms and keep the rooms clear of debris associated with maintenance activities.
- Use an evaporator bypass damper, variable airflow rate, and/or defrost cycle to ensure operation during cooler lights-off or end-of-grow-cycle conditions, which can be as low as 18°C at 40% rh (4°C dp).
  - Careful consideration must be made with regard to the derating of the capacity of the dehumidifiers in reduced temperature environments, such as nighttime use and more prevalently drying room use.
  - Dry rooms may have significant initial water vapor loading for the first two days of the dry period to reach 50% weight goals to reduce the potential propagation of molds within the harvested materials.
  - The transition from day to night in a grow room is the largest water removal rate ratio, effectively a negative sensible heat ratio where the combined HVAC system should only be dehumidifying and warming the room with basically neutral air. This period is generally more than 30 min and less than an hour, depending upon the size of plants. This period, if not properly addressed, exposes the plants to very high relative humidity, both choking the plants ability to transpire, causing condensation, and propagation of fungus and bacteria.
- Use minimum efficiency reporting value (MERV) 13 filters or better to provide adequate mold spore reducing filtration (see ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2 for details on MERV filters)
  - Many times the dehumidifiers cannot be equipped with proper filters. In this case, using ducted dehumidifiers as a sidestream to the main cooling equipment can be arranged to provide filtered air to the dehumidifier.
- Controls integration between the dehumidification units and the primary cooling/conditioning system is required to eliminate hunting of the room. Typical on-board controls for unitary dehumidifiers reference local relative humidity, and that sensor will be affected by changes in the room temperature.
  - For instance, cycling DX type systems can cause run away hunting between the primary cooling and the dehumidification systems, causing over drying of the room, or over heating of the room.
  - Most dehumidification units are fitted with remote relays to trigger their stages, and those should be tied into an electronic controls system so that the dehumidification units may be staged appropriately along with the cooling and reheat provided by the main conditioning system.
  - Many rooms require multiple dehumidifiers to address the water load. By not interconnecting them, large swings in humidity will be experienced, even if using staggered set points between the units.

General Considerations. Because most grow rooms are sensible cooling primary load facilities, care is needed to ensure that heat gain from the dehumidification process can be managed by the existing or designed sensible cooling devices. A CEA dehumidifier can be selected with remote heat rejection to provide some or all of the sensible cooling required. This approach may achieve better energy management by ensuring that the facility is not forced to oversize or overuse sensible cooling devices to counter heat gain from dehumidification equipment in the space.

Grow rooms can require washdown cycles. Ensure that selected equipment has washdown capabilities to reduce pathogen and mold growth, and that filters are easily accessible for regular replacement.

CEA rooms should be considered process air and handled appropriately as such. The typical relative humidity excursions from set point that are typically acceptable in a comfort cooling environment are not acceptable for grow rooms.

Dehumidification of grow rooms is a wildly variable application of HVAC equipment. The room calculations should be made for selections of the equipment in an all-sensible environment: lights and fans on, but no plants. They should also be made for the heaviest day condition: lights on and loaded with plants transpiring at the maximum expected amount. What is commonly missed is calculating the day-night transition and the steady-state night conditions. All four of these major load cases must be satisfied successfully by the combination of central cooling and unitary dehumidification units. Further, these load cases should be calculated for young plants entering rooms that can be over-dried with systems that cannot be turned down or bypassed to reduce the water removal rate.

When looking at the calculations for the sensible and latent heat loads within the room, the engineer should be mindful that the plants themselves do not constitute a latent load as they are not a heat source. The plants will take the energy from the lights, and as long as the vapor pressure deficit is correct for them to transpire, the transpiration will convert the sensible load from the room into a latent load through the latent heat of evaporation. With this in mind, the calculations can be made for the maximum sensible load (lights on, no plants) and the maximum water removal rate, which can actually require more energy than the sensible case, making the SHR of the total system effectively 0 or negative.

The calculations should not add the calculated sensible and latent loads. The calculation should start with the total sensible energy gain into the room as case 1. This is very easily addressed by the main cooling system. Then, the watering recipes should be examined to find the steady state transpiration load into the room. This transpiration converts sensible heat into latent heat through adiabatic cooling. When looking at case 2 (lights on/ heavy plants), the engineer may find that the water load going into the room creates a latent load that exceeds the lighting power. This is often the case in nurseries where there can be heavy young, non-flowering plants, within a space with nursery-level lighting. The engineer should then select dehumidification equipment to address the water load, taking into consideration the contribution from the main cooling equipment, and then recalculating the main cooling equipment with the dehumidification heat rejection taken into consideration. In many cases, the reheat provided by the dehumidification equipment can make up for the sensible shortfall, allowing the main cooling equipment to be roughly equivalent size as the sensible case. In many existing installations, Engineers have made the mistake of adding the sensible and latent loads together.

Then, the selected equipment should be calculated against the two final operating conditions: case 3 (lights off/plants transpiring) and case 4 (lights off/plants asleep). Case 3 represents a pure dehumidification operation case. The sensible heating elements are all shut down, while the plants continue to transpire at the same rate they had during the day for a period of about 40 minutes (±15 min). However, the systems should not immediately decrease the temperature set point at the same time, or there will be an over-cooling (further pressure on relative humidity) followed by an over-drying condition when the plants go to sleep. Case 4 represents the lights off hours where the plants have gone to sleep. The transpiration load typically decreases to about 5 to 10% of the daytime rate and there is no real sensible loads aside from circulation fans and the building envelope.

The issue here is that the equipment will not be sized appropriately (oversized) and cause short cycling. This short cycling not

only leads to shorter equipment life, but it causes severe control excursions with respect to room humidity. The classic example is a dry room served by a two stage direct-expansion packaged HVAC unit when the DX coils both cycle off. The wet coil allows the discharge air humidity to spike and it takes some time for the system to cycle back on. This can cause excessive condensation within the supply ducts, water intrusion into the rooms, etc.

Dehumidification for CEA rooms is crucial to maintaining the water vapor levels, and what growers call **vapor pressure deficit (VPD)**. This is simply the concept of relative humidity (rh) with a specific bent towards the vapor pressure of water rather than just a percent of total carrying capacity. The plants are able to transpire when the vapor pressure deficit is ideal across the stomata. Growers target different VPDs for different parts of the plant's life, the type or strain of plant, and what they are trying to achieve with that plant.

Maintenance of VPD is more important than maintaining temperature. If the plant can continue to transpire, even in over- or under-temperature excursions, there will not likely be damage to the plants. In this way, dehumidification equipment becomes the driving factor in the system design. Over-temperature conditions of a space is OK, as long as it is not too dry. However, allowing a space to get overly wet in order to maintain the space temperature is a recipe for fungus and poor plant health, even for short periods of time. Very great care should be taken when considering equipment to eliminate short cycling, maintenance of off-cycle conditions, etc.

VPD, like relative humidity, is based on temperature. So, it is possible to achieve the proper VPD at any given operating temperature. Because of this, it should be assumed that the plant can and will transpire water into the space at the given watering rates, no matter the temperature within the room. It also means, that great care should be taken when transitioning set points and operating conditions.

The largest example of this is the change from day mode to night mode. Day mode set points can generally be in the upper 20s or over 30°C with relative humidity in the 55 to 65% range. By the end of the day, the plants are transpiring at their steady day awake levels, and then the lights are either dimmed and turned off or just shut off quickly. In this event, it is critical to keep the night set point from being a double-step-change on the control systems because the lights have gone out, the sensible load in the room has all but been eliminated and the plants continue to transpire. It is very typical to see relative humidity spike out after the lights shut off in conventionally constructed grow rooms. When this happens, damage can occur to the plants as they suffocate in this condition. The propagation of fungus is also typically associated with this transition period.

In addition to the above conditions, it should be noted that grow rooms are to be considered harsh environments. There is dust and intense UV light, and the space is typically cleaned with strong chemicals between harvests to eliminate pests, fungus, bacteria, etc. Ensure that the equipment, ductwork, filters, etc., have been selected to give long service life even if treated with chemicals such as chlorine dioxide, hydrogen peroxide, etc. Further, the operators may use a wash-down approach to these spaces. Investigate the intended cleaning standard operating procedures or consider signage on the equipment if it might be susceptible to certain chemicals or conditions.

Tunnel Dryer Dehumidifier

A general-purpose dehumidifier system removes moisture from a product inside the drying tunnel. Air at the desired temperature and humidity constantly recirculates around the product, continuously removing moisture. Tunnel dryer dehumidifier design is similar to that of a general-purpose dehumidifier (see Figure 4). Because of the closely controlled space humidity, temperature, and airflow, select the dehumidifying and reheat coils in accordance with the following conditions:

- The dehumidifying coil must have variable apparatus dew-point control; it might also have an air bypass, depending on coil selection.
- The reheat coil needs variable reheat control.
- A means of external heat rejection is required (e.g., heat rejection to a heat pump loop, chilled-water loop, fluid cooler, or remote air-cooled condenser).

Process Considerations. A precision control system is required to prevent overdrying by automatically shutting off or by reducing capacity when the moisture content in the product has reached the desired level. Continuous control of temperature and relative humidity improves the drying process and maintains product quality, and potentially can reduce operating cost compared to ventilation only. Users should be able to specify drying temperature to best preserve initial product quality.

Design Considerations. The usual operating range for tunnel dryer dehumidifiers is 15 to 38°C db and 10 to 38°C dew point. An average air velocity of 2.54 m/s across the tunnel net free area is recommended for effective drying.

Tunnels should be no longer than 9 m, to prevent saturated air at the tunnel's end. Construction must be air- and vaportight to prevent moisture infiltration from surrounding spaces.

Some products may produce corrosive contaminants, so tunnel dryer dehumidifier components should be corrosion resistant.

For a typical installation of a tunnel dryer dehumidifier, see Figure 15.

2. CONTROLS AND SENSORS

Care is needed when locating the humidity-sensing device that triggers compressor operation. A poorly located sensor results in failure of the system to properly control the humidity levels. The sensor must be located in an area that gives an accurate reading and feedback of the conditions needing control. In larger-volume areas, multiple sensors with an averaging algorithm might provide the best result. Consider the following when selecting sensor locations:

- If the supply fan cycles on/off with compressor operation, this scenario is likely to produce the least accurate sensor reading. Unless the sensor can be located in an area where the humidity

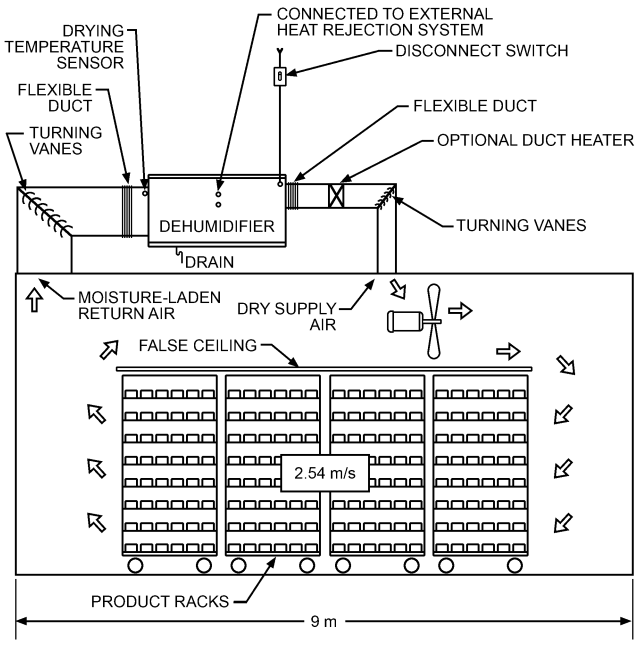

Fig. 15 Typical Tunnel Dryer Dehumidifier

levels are representative of the space when there is no air circulation, the supply fan should be set on a timer to operate on a regular cycle. This ensures air turnover and better monitoring and control of the conditioned space.

- Natatorium dehumidifiers usually have sensors mounted on the unit because of the space high air turnover rate and continuous fan operation. Ensure that the air distribution system does not introduce dry supply air into the return; otherwise, the control system might incorrectly sense that the space is satisfied.
- DOAS units typically have all sensors mounted on the unit and are configured to deliver neutral air. Some units have space-mounted temperature sensors to trigger a full cooling mode (no reheat) to contribute to the space's sensible cooling requirements. This operational mode requires a space-mounted thermostat.
- DOAS units are often configured with 100% recirculation or a percentage of recirculation mode operation, and are tasked for space cooling, heating, and humidity control. Proper location of these space-mounted temperature and humidity sensors is vital for the equipment to provide proper space control.

Heat recovery devices require additional sensors for proper operation.

3. INSTALLATION AND SERVICE CONSIDERATIONS

Equipment and sensors must be installed properly so that they function in accordance with manufacturers' specifications. Interconnecting diagrams for the low-voltage control system should be documented for proper future servicing. Planning is important for installing large, roof-mounted equipment because special rigging is frequently required.

The refrigerant circuit must be clean, dry, and leak-free. An advantage of packaged equipment is that proper installation minimizes the risk of field contamination of the circuit. Take care to properly install split-system interconnecting tubing (e.g., proper cleanliness, brazing, evacuation to remove moisture). Charge split systems according to the manufacturer's instructions.

Equipment must be located to avoid noise and vibration problems. Mount single-package equipment of over 70 kW capacity on concrete pads if vibration control is a concern. Large-capacity equipment should be roof mounted only after the roof's structural adequacy has been evaluated. Additional installation guidelines include the following:

- In general, install products containing compressors on solid, level surfaces.
- Avoid mounting products containing compressors (e.g., remote units) on or touching the foundation of a building. A separate pad that does not touch the foundation is recommended to reduce noise and vibration transmission through the slab.
- Do not box in outdoor air-cooled units with fences, walls, overhangs, or bushes. Doing so reduces the unit's air-moving ability, reducing efficiency.
- For a split-system remote unit, choose an installation site that is close to the indoor part of the system to minimize refrigerant charge and pressure drop in the connecting refrigerant tubing.
- Contact the equipment manufacturer or consult the installation instructions for further information on installation procedures.

Equipment should be listed or certified by nationally recognized testing laboratories to ensure safe operation and compliance with government and utility regulations. Equipment should also be installed to comply with agency standards' rating and application requirements to ensure that it performs according to industry criteria. Larger and more specialized equipment often does not carry agency labeling. However, power and control wiring practices should comply with the *National Electrical Code*® (NFPA *Standard* 70). Consult local codes before design, and consult local inspectors before installation.

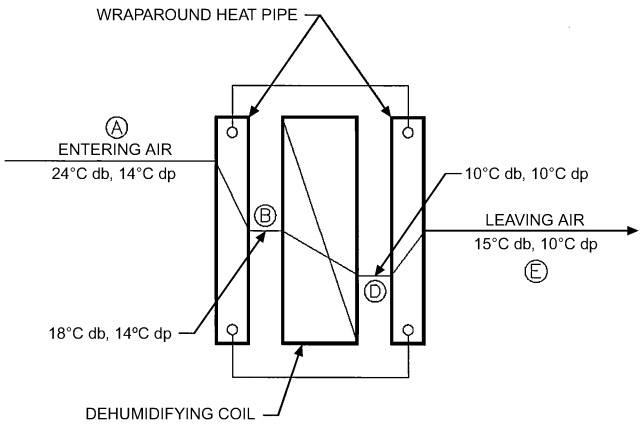

Fig. 16 Schematic of Dehumidification Enhancement with Wraparound Heat Pipe

A clear, accurate wiring diagram and well-written service manual are essential to the installer and service personnel. Easy, safe service access must be provided for cleaning, lubrication, and periodic maintenance of filters and belts. In addition, access for replacement of major components must be provided and preserved.

Service personnel must be qualified to repair or replace mechanical and electrical components and to recover and properly recycle or dispose of any refrigerant removed from a system. They must also understand the importance of controlling moisture and other contaminants in the refrigerant circuit; they should know how to clean a hermetic system if it has been opened for service (see Chapter 7 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*). Proper service procedures help ensure that the equipment continues operating efficiently for its expected life.

4. WRAPAROUND HEAT EXCHANGERS

An air-to-air heat exchanger (heat pipe, coil runaround loop, fixed-plate heat exchanger, or rotary heat exchanger) in a series (or wraparound) configuration can be used to enhance moisture removal by a mechanical dehumidifier, improving efficiency, and possibly allowing reduced refrigeration capacity in new systems. Other uses of air-to-air heat exchangers are covered in Chapter 26.

Air-to-air heat exchangers are used with a mechanical dehumidification system to passively move heat from one place to another. The most common configuration used for dehumidification is the **runaround** (or **wraparound**) configuration (Figure 16), which removes sensible heat from the entering airstream and passively transfers it to the leaving airstream. (Points A to E correspond to points labeled in Figure 17.) This improves the cooling coil's latent dehumidification capacity. This method can be applied if design calculations have accounted for the condition of air entering the evaporator coil.

In the runaround or wraparound configuration (Figure 16), one section of the air-to-air heat exchanger is placed upstream of the cooling coil and the other section is placed downstream of the cooling coil. The air is precooled before entering the cooling coil. Heat absorbed by the upstream section of the air-to-air heat exchanger is then passively transferred to air leaving the cooling coil (or supply airstream) by the downstream heat exchanger.

Sensible precooling by the air-to-air heat exchanger reduces the sensible load on the cooling coil, allowing an increase in its latent capacity (Figure 17). The combination of these two effects lowers the system SHR, much like the process described in the Mechani-

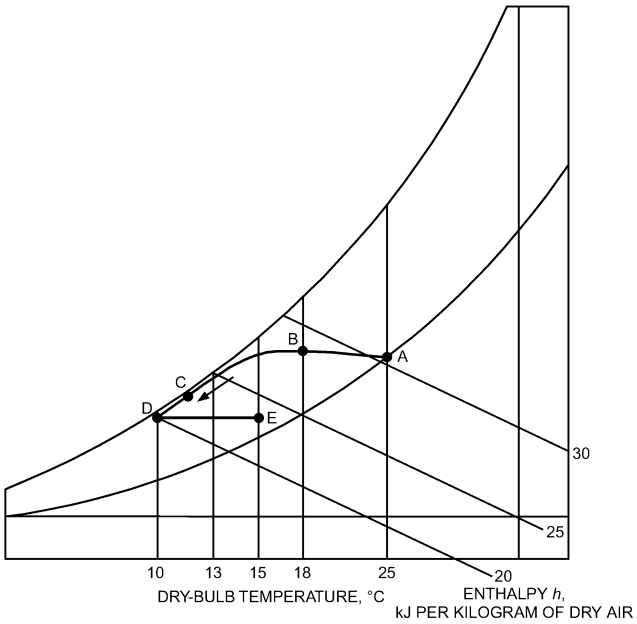

Fig. 17 Enhanced Dehumidification Process with Wraparound Heat Pipe

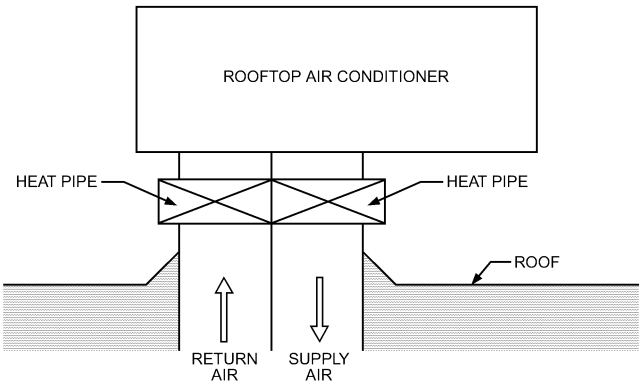

Fig. 18 Slide-in Heat Pipe for Rooftop Air Conditioner Refit

(Kittler 1996)

cal Dehumidifiers section. Adding the air-to-air heat exchanger brings the condition of air entering the evaporator coil closer to the saturation line on the psychrometric chart (A to B). In new installations, this requires careful evaporator coil design that accounts for the actual range of air conditions after the air-to-air heat exchanger, which may differ significantly from the return air conditions.

In retrofits, the **duct-to-duct** (or **slide-in**) configuration (Figure 18) is sometimes used. One section of the air-to-air heat exchanger is placed in the return airstream, and the other section in the supply airstream. This configuration, however, may not provide as much benefit as the wraparound configuration (Figure 16), when (1) the upstream side of the heat exchanger is located upstream of where outdoor air enters the system, (2) smaller duct sizes result in higher air velocity reducing the effectiveness and increases the air-side pressure drop of the heat exchanger, and (3) it requires an additional filter upstream of the air-to-air heat exchanger.

In retrofits, the lower entering-air temperature at the evaporator coil lowers the temperature of air leaving the evaporator coil. Evaporator coil capacity is reduced because of the lower entering wet-bulb temperature, changing the system's operating point. This must be analyzed to ensure that the mechanical refrigeration system still operates correctly. If evaporator coil freeze-up is possible, the system must include some means to modulate the capacity of (or deactivate) the air-to-air heat exchanger or bypass airflow to prevent evaporator freezing. Having the ability to modulate the air-to-air heat exchanger's capacity may be incorporated to better meet the load requirement of the mechanical dehumidifier.

Adding an air-to-air heat exchanger typically improves the moisture removal capacity of an existing mechanical dehumidification system by creating a lower supply air dew point, while providing some reheat without additional energy use. Proper design practices are necessary to ensure that the unit's mechanical refrigeration system still operates efficiently with the new entering air conditions and additional air-side pressure drop. Also, the added pressure drop of the air-to-air heat exchanger is likely to reduce the airflow delivered, unless fan speed in increased. If increasing fan speed is necessary, verify that the fan motor can handle the added load.

Figure 17 shows the dehumidification process when a wraparound heat pipe is added to an existing evaporator coil. Point A to C shows the cooling and dehumidification process of an existing DX evaporator coil, without the wraparound heat pipe. Point A to B shows precooling by the upstream section of heat pipe. The process line from B to D (versus B to C, without the wraparound heat pipe) shows how the evaporator coil's dehumidification performance improves (lowering leaving air dew point, from C to D) if a wraparound heat pipe is added to the existing system, because the enthalpy of the air entering the evaporator is lowered. Point D to E illustrates that the heat removed from air upstream of the evaporator (A to B) is added back into air leaving the evaporator. The total amount of heat energy (enthalpy) removed in section A-B is equal to the amount of heat added in section D-E.

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CHAPTER 26

AIR-TO-AIR ENERGY RECOVERY EQUIPMENT

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Basic Heat or Heat and Water Vapor Transfer Relations 26.2
Types of Air-to-Air Heat Exchangers 26.5
Performance Ratings 26.17
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AIR-TO-AIR energy recovery is the process of recovering heat and/or moisture between two airstreams at different temperatures and humidities. This process is important in maintaining acceptable indoor air quality (IAQ) while keeping energy costs low and reducing overall energy consumption and carbon dioxide emission. This chapter describes various technologies for air-to-air energy recovery. Thermal and economic performance, maintenance, and related operational issues are presented, with emphasis on energy recovery for ventilation.

Air-to-air energy recovery should be considered for every building in which energy is used to condition the air. This is consistent with ASHRAE's strategic plan to support a sustainable built environment, and aligns with the United Nations International Panel for Climate Change's call for action to reduce the emissions of carbon dioxide related to energy use.

Energy can be recovered either in its sensible (temperature only) or latent (moisture) form, or a combination of both from multiple sources. Sensible energy can be extracted, for example, from outgoing airstreams in dryers, ovens, furnaces, combustion chambers, and gas turbine exhaust gases to heat supply air. Units used for this purpose are called **sensible heat exchange devices** or **heat recovery ventilators (HRVs)**. Devices that transfer both heat and moisture are known as **energy** or **enthalpy devices** or **energy recovery ventilators (ERVs)**. HRVs and ERVs are available for commercial and industrial applications as well as for residential and small-scale commercial uses.

Air conditioners use significant energy to dehumidify moist airstreams. Excessive moisture in the air of a building can result in mold, allergies, and bacterial growth. ERVs can enhance dehumidification with packaged unitary air conditioners. Introducing outdoor or ventilation air is the primary means of diluting air contaminants to achieve acceptable indoor air quality. ERVs can cost-effectively provide large amounts of outdoor air to meet a building's minimum ventilation requirements as prescribed in ASHRAE *Standards* 62.1 and 62.2.

Types of HRV/ERVs include fixed-plate heat (or enthalpy) exchangers, rotary wheels, heat pipes, runaround loops, thermosiphons, fixed-bed regenerators, and twin-tower enthalpy recovery loops. Performance is typically characterized by effectiveness; pressure drop, pumping, or fan power of fluids; cross leakage (i.e., amount of air leakage from one stream to the other); and frost control (used to prevent frosting on the heat exchanger). **Recovery efficiency ratio (RER)**, the ratio of output of a device to its input, is also often considered. In energy recovery ventilators, effectiveness refers to the ratio of actual energy or moisture recovered to the maximum possible amount of energy and/or moisture that can be recovered.

Fluid stream pressure drops because of the friction between the fluid and solid surface, and because of the geometrical complexity of the flow passages. Pumping or fan power is the product of the fluid volume flow rate and pressure drop. Economic factors such as cost of energy recovered and capital and maintenance cost (including pumping power cost) play a vital role in determining the economic feasibility of recovery ventilators for a given application.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 5.5, Air-to-Air Energy Recovery.

Table 1 Typical Applications for Air-to-Air Energy Recovery

Method	Application
Comfort-to-comfort	Residences
	Offices
	Classrooms
	Retail
	Bars and restaurants
	Swimming pools
	Locker rooms
	Operating rooms
	Nursing homes
	Animal ventilation
	Plant ventilation
	Smoking exhaust
Process-to-process and Process-to-comfort	Dryers
	Ovens
	Flue stacks
	Burners
	Furnaces
	Incinerators
	Paint exhaust
	Welding exhaust

1. APPLICATIONS

Air-to-air energy recovery systems may be categorized according to their application as (1) process-to-process, (2) process-to-comfort, or (3) comfort-to-comfort. Some typical air-to-air energy recovery applications are listed in Table 1.

In **comfort-to-comfort** applications, the energy recovery device lowers the enthalpy of the building supply air during warm weather and raises it during cold weather by transferring energy between the ventilation air supply and exhaust airstreams.

Air-to-air energy recovery devices for comfort-to-comfort applications may be sensible heat exchange devices (i.e., transferring sensible energy only) or energy exchange devices (i.e., transferring both sensible energy and moisture). These devices are discussed further in the section on Additional Technical Considerations.

When outdoor air humidity is low and the building space has an appreciable latent load, an ERV can recover sensible energy while possibly slightly increasing the latent space load because of water vapor transfer within the ERV. It is therefore important to determine whether the given application calls for HRV or ERV.

HRVs are suitable in applications when outdoor air humidity is low and latent space loads are moderate or high for most of the year, and also for use with high-indoor-humidity and hazardous-exhaust applications such as swimming pools, chemical exhaust, paint booths, and indirect evaporative coolers.

ERVs are suitable for moderate- to high-outdoor-humidity applications and those that require year-round economical preheating and/or precooling of outdoor supply air.

In **process-to-process** applications, heat is captured from the process exhaust stream and transferred to the process supply airstream. Equipment is available to handle process exhaust temperatures as high as 870°C.

Process-to-process recovery devices generally recover only sensible heat and do not transfer latent heat, because moisture transfer is usually detrimental to the process. In cases involving condensable gases, less recovery may be desired to prevent condensation and possible corrosion.

In **process-to-comfort** applications, waste heat captured from process exhaust heats building makeup air during winter. Typical applications include foundries, strip-coating plants, can plants, plating operations, pulp and paper plants, and other processing areas with heated process exhaust and large makeup air volume requirements.

Although full recovery is usually desired in process-to-process applications, recovery for process-to-comfort applications must be modulated during warm weather to prevent overheating the makeup air. During summer, no recovery is required. Because energy is saved only in the winter and recovery is modulated during moderate weather, process-to-comfort applications save less energy annually than do process-to-process applications.

Process-to-comfort recovery devices generally recover sensible heat only and do not transfer moisture between airstreams.

2. BASIC HEAT OR HEAT AND WATER VAPOR TRANSFER RELATIONS

The second law of thermodynamics states that heat energy always transfers from a region of high temperature to one of low temperature. This law can be extended to say that mass transfer always occurs from a region of high vapor pressure to one of low vapor pressure. The conceptual energy recovery exchanger in Figure 1 facilitates this transfer (without mixing supply and exhaust airstreams) across a separating wall (shown by a thick horizontal line in Figure 1) made of a material that conducts heat and is permeable to water vapor. Heat is transferred when there is a difference in temperature between the two airstreams. Moisture is transferred when there is a difference in vapor pressure between the two airstreams.

On a typical summer day, supply air at temperature, humidity, or enthalpy of x_1 and mass flow rate m_s enters the ERV, while exhaust air from the conditioned space enters at conditions x_3 and m_3. Because conditions at x_3 are lower than conditions at x_1, heat and mass transfer from the supply airstream to the exhaust airstream because of differences in temperature and vapor pressures across the separating wall. Consequently, the supply air exit properties decrease, while those of the exhaust air increase.

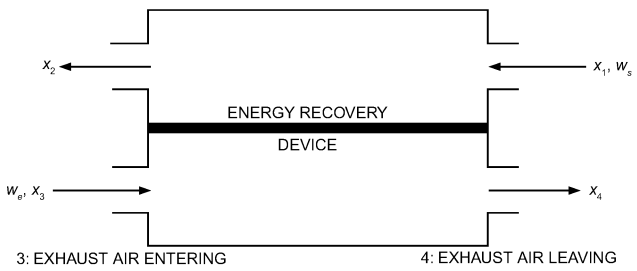

Fig. 1 Airstream Numbering Convention

Effectiveness

When mass flow rates, temperatures, and humidities of the inlets and outlets are known, the sensible, latent, or total effectiveness of the exchanger for those operating conditions can be determined.

Conversely, if the respective effectiveness of the exchanger at specific mass flow rates is known or rated, and the temperatures and humidities of the inlets are specified, it is possible to estimate conditions at the outlets, as long as confounding variables such as occurrence of condensation or internal leakages are insignificant.

The general definition of transfer effectiveness ε, on which ASHRAE *Standard* 84 bases its definitions of effectiveness, is

$$\varepsilon = \frac{\text{Actual transfer of moisture and/or energy}}{\text{Maximum possible transfer between airstreams}} \quad (1)$$

Referring to Figure 1, the gross sensible effectiveness ε_s or $\varepsilon_{sensible}$ of an energy recovery ventilator is given as

$$\varepsilon_{sensible} = \frac{\dot{m}_2(c_{p,1}T_1 - c_{p,2}T_2)}{\dot{m}_{min}(c_{p,1}T_1 - c_{p,3}T_3)} \quad (2a)$$

Referring to Figure 1, the gross latent effectiveness ε_L or ε_{latent} of an energy recovery ventilator is given as

$$\varepsilon_{latent} = \frac{\dot{m}_2(h_{fg,1}W_1 - h_{fg,2}W_2)}{\dot{m}_{min}(h_{fg,1}W_1 - h_{fg,3}W_3)} \quad (2b)$$

Referring to Figure 1, the gross total effectiveness ε_T or ε_{total} of an energy recovery ventilator is given as

$$\varepsilon_{total} = \frac{\dot{m}_2(h_1 - h_2)}{\dot{m}_{min}(h_1 - h_3)} \quad (2c)$$

where

$\dot{m}_n$ = mass flow rate at station n, kg/s
$\dot{m}_{min}$ = minimum of $\dot{m}_2$ and $\dot{m}_3$, kg/s
$c_{p,n}$ = specific heat of dry air at station n, kJ/(kg·K)
h_{fg} = heat of vaporization of water, kJ/(kg·K)
T_n = dry-bulb temperature at station n, °C
W_n = humidity at station n, kg_w/kg_{da}
h_n = enthalpy at station n, kJ/kg

Note that in Equations (2a), (2b), and (2c), the denominators express the theoretical maximum sensible, latent, or total energy transfer.

An additional figure of merit, which characterizes the reduction in heating or cooling load associated with the supply air, is the **enthalpy recovery ratio**, given by

$$\text{Enthalpy recovery ratio} = \frac{h_1 - h_2}{h_1 - h_3} \quad (3)$$

where h is enthalpy at station n, in kJ/kg.

Equation (3) bears a superficial resemblance to Equation (2c) which defines gross total effectiveness, but when the supply and exhaust mass flows through the exchanger are different, the two metrics may have different values. Using the enthalpy recovery ratio when designing HVAC systems for compliance with ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 is detailed in the section on Performance Ratings.

The leaving supply air conditions and heat transfer rates easily can be estimated under ideal conditions: steady-state operation; no heat or moisture transfer between the heat exchanger and its surroundings; no cross-leakage; and no energy gains or losses from motors, fans, or frost control devices, with negligible condensation or frosting. Under such ideal conditions, the leaving supply temperature is

$$T_2 = \frac{\dot{m}_2 c_{p,1} T_1 - \varepsilon_{sensible} \dot{m}_{min} (c_{p,1} T_1 - c_{p,3} T_3)}{\dot{m}_2 c_{p,2}} \quad (4a)$$

and the exhaust air temperature is

$$T_4 = \frac{\dot{m}_2 c_{p,3} T_3 + \varepsilon_{sensible} \dot{m}_{min} (c_{p,1} T_1 - c_{p,3} T_3)}{\dot{m}_2 c_{p,2}} \quad (4b)$$

The leaving supply air humidity is

$$W_2 = \frac{\dot{m}_2 h_{fg,1} W_1 - \varepsilon_{latent} \dot{m}_{min} (h_{fg,1} W_1 - h_{fg,1} W_3)}{\dot{m}_2 h_{fg,2}} \quad (4c)$$

And the exhaust air humidity is

$$W_4 = \frac{\dot{m}_2 h_{fg,3} W_3 + \varepsilon_{latent} \dot{m}_{min} (h_{fg,1} W_1 - h_{fg,3} W_3)}{\dot{m}_2 h_{fg,2}} \quad (4d)$$

The leaving supply air enthalpy is

$$h_2 = h_1 - \varepsilon_{total} \frac{\dot{m}_{min}}{\dot{m}_s} (h_1 - h_3) \quad (4e)$$

And the exhaust air enthalpy is

$$h_4 = h_3 - \varepsilon_{total} \frac{\dot{m}_{min}}{\dot{m}_s} (h_1 - h_3) \quad (4f)$$

Use Equations (4e) and (4f) with caution. When the enthalpies of the entering airstreams are very close but the temperatures and humidities are not, it is possible for the calculated total effectiveness to be greater than or less than both of the sensible or latent effectivenesses, or even to be greater than 100% or less than 0%. For example, in some conditions, the supply airstream flowing through an ERV may gain heat energy ($+q_s$) from the adjoining stream but lose latent energy ($-q_L$) if it transfers the water vapor to the adjoining stream. Therefore, it is generally best to determine the expected enthalpy of leaving air by first calculating the expected temperature and humidity of the leaving air.

The sensible heat energy transfer q_s in the energy recovery exchanger can be estimated from

$$q_s = \dot{m}_2 (c_{p,1} T_1 - c_{p,2} T_2) = Q_2 \rho_2 (c_{p,1} T_1 - c_{p,2} T_2) \quad (5a)$$

where

q_s = sensible heat transfer, kW
c_p = specific heat of air, kJ/(kg·K)
Q_2 = volume flow rate of supply outlet air, m^3/s
ρ_2 = density of dry outlet supply air, kg/m^3
t_1, t_2, t_3 = inlet and exit temperatures of supply inlet, supply outlet, and exhaust inlet airstreams, respectively, K
$\dot{m}_2$ = mass flow rate of supply air inlet, kg/s

The latent heat transfer q_L in the energy recovery exchanger can be estimated from

$$q_L = \dot{m}_2 (h_{fg,1} W_1 - h_{fg,2} W_2) = Q_2 \rho_2 (h_{fg,1} W_1 - h_{fg,2} W_2) \quad (5b)$$

where

q_L = latent heat transfer, kW
h_{fg} = enthalpy or heat of vaporization of water, kJ/kg
W_1, W_2, W_3=inlet and exit humidity ratios of the supply inlet, supply outlet, and exhaust inlet airstreams, respectively, kg_w/kg_{da}

Similarly, humidity transfer q_w in the ERV can be estimated from

$$q_w = \dot{m}_2 (W_1 - W_2) = Q_2 \rho_2 (W_1 - W_2) \quad (5c)$$

where q_w is humidity transfer, in kg_w/s

In some cases, the total energy transfer q_T or q_{total} can be estimated from

$$q_{total} = \dot{m}_2 (h_1 - h_2) = Q_2 \rho_2 (h_1 - h_2) \quad (5d)$$

where q_h is total energy transfer, kilowatts

However, in the somewhat unusual case when the supply airstream gains sensible energy but loses water content, q_{total} is best estimated from

$$q_{total} = q_s + q_L \quad (5e)$$

Heat or energy exchange effectiveness as defined in Equations (1), (2a), (2b), and (2c) is used to characterize each type of energy transfer in air-to-air exchangers. For a given set of inlet properties and flow rates, knowledge of each effectiveness allows the designer to calculate the sensible, latent, and total energy transfer rates using Equations (5a), (5b), and (5d), respectively. These effectiveness values can be determined either from measured test data or using correlations that have been verified in the peer-reviewed engineering literature. These correlations can also be used to predict energy transfer rates and outlet air properties for operating conditions different from those used for certification purposes. Predicting effectiveness for noncertified operating conditions using certified test data is the most common use of correlations for HVAC designs, though the practice is less necessary since AHRI *Standard* 1060 revised certification requirements requiring manufacturers to certify AAERV selection software that can predict performance at a range of operating conditions. AAERV performance for entering air conditions outside of certified mapped performance ranges must still be extrapolated based on tested and/or certified values. Although correlations are not available for all types of air-to-air exchangers under all operating conditions, they are available for the most common types of air-to-air exchanger under operating conditions which have no condensation or frosting.

Rate of Energy Transfer

The rate of energy transfer depends on the operating conditions and the intrinsic characteristics of the energy exchanger, such as the geometry of the exchanger (parallel flow/counterflow/ cross-flow, number of passes, fins), thermal conductivity of walls separating the streams, and permeability of walls to various gases. As in a conventional heat exchanger, energy transfer between the airstreams is driven by cross-stream dry-bulb temperature differences. Energy is also transported piggyback-style between the streams by cross-stream mass transfer, which may include air, gases, and water vapor. In another mode of energy transfer, water vapor condenses into liquid in one of the two airstreams of the exchanger. The condensation process liberates the latent heat of condensation, which is transferred to the other stream as sensible heat; this two-step process is also called **latent heat transfer**.

Latent energy transfer between airstreams occurs only when moisture is transferred from one airstream to another without condensation, thereby maintaining the latent heat of condensation. Once moisture has crossed from one airstream to the other, it may

either remain in the vapor state or condense in the second stream, depending on the temperature of that stream.

Rotating-wheel and fixed-plate enthalpy exchangers are used because of their moisture exchange function. Some cross-stream mass transfer may also occur through leakage even when such transfer is unintended. This may alter exchanger performance from its design value, but for most HVAC applications with exhaust air from occupied spaces, small transfers to the supply air are not important. However, these transfers can and should be evaluated during design, and in many cases can be controlled.

Heat transfer differs in principle from mass transfer. Heat transfer only occurs when there is a temperature difference. In the case of air-to-air exchange between the supply and exhaust airflow, heat transfer by conduction and convection only occurs when there is a temperature difference between these airstreams. Remember the following facts about heat/mass exchanger performance:

- Effectiveness for moisture transfer may not equal the effectiveness for heat transfer.
- Total energy effectiveness may not equal either the sensible or latent effectiveness.

Net total energy transfer and effectiveness need careful examination when the direction of sensible (temperature-driven) transfer is opposite to that of latent (moisture or water vapor) transfer.

ERV performance is expressed by the magnitudes of pumping power and sensible, latent, or total energy recovered. The energy recovered is estimated from the exit temperatures or humidity ratios, which are directly related to the effectiveness. Effectiveness is a function of two parameters: the number of transfer units (NTU) and thermal flow capacity ratio C_r.

$$\text{NTU} = UA/C_{min} \tag{6}$$

$$C_r = C_{min}/C_{max} \tag{7}$$

where

U = overall heat transfer coefficient, related to flow rates and dimensions of fluid flow path in heat exchanger, kW/(m^2·K)
A = area of heat exchanger, m^2
C_{min}, C_{max} = minimum and maximum capacity rates, expressed for sensible as $m_s c_{p,s}$ and $m_e c_{p,e}$

See Figure 8 for the variation of effectiveness with NTU for a rotary heat wheel. Variation of effectiveness is similar for plate exchangers.

Example 1. Inlet supply air enters an ERV with a flow rate of 4.41 m^3/s at 35°C and 20% rh. Inlet exhaust air enters with a flow rate of 4.27 m^3/s at 24°C and 50% rh. Assume that the energy exchanger was tested under ASHRAE *Standard* 84, which rated the sensible heat transfer effectiveness at 50% and the latent (water vapor) transfer effectiveness at 50%. With the simplifying assumptions that the specific heat of air is 1 kJ/(kg·K) and the latent heat of vaporization is 2560 kJ/kg, determine the sensible, latent, and net energy transferred in the exchanger.

Solution:

From the psychrometric chart, the properties of air at 35°C and 20% rh are

$V_1 = 0.8825$ m^3/kg $\quad h_1 = 54.2$ kJ/kg $\quad w_1 = 0.0071$ kg/kg of dry air

and the properties of air at 24°C and 50% rh are

$V_3 = 0.854$ m^3/kg $\quad h_3 = 48$ kJ/kg $\quad w_3 = 0.0093$ kg/kg of dry air

The mass flow rate at state 1 is obtained from

$$\{m_1 = \frac{Q_1}{v_1} = \frac{4.41 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}}{0.8825 \text{ m}^3/\text{kg}} = 5.0 \text{ kg/s}\}$$

Similarly, the mass flow rate at state 3 is obtained from

$$m_3 = \frac{Q_3}{v_3} = \frac{4.27 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}}{0.854 \text{ m}^3/\text{kg}} = 5.0 \text{ kg/s}$$

Exit temperatures of the supply airstream can be obtained from Equation (4a):

$$t_2 = \frac{50(1)35 - 0.50(50)\{(1)35 - (1)24\}}{(50)1} = 29.5°\text{C}$$

The exit humidity of the supply airstream is found from Equation (4c):

$$w_2 = \{5.0(2560)0.0071 - 0.50(5.0)[(2560)0.0071 - (2560)0.0093]\}/[(5.0)(2560)] = 0.0080 \text{ kg}_w/\text{kg}_{da}$$

The sensible heat transfer q_s in the exchanger is found from Equation (5a):

$$q_s = 5.0(1 \times 35 - 1 \times 29.5) = 27.5 \text{ kW}$$

The latent heat transfer q_L in the exchanger is found from Equation (5b):

$$q_L = 5.0[(2560)(0.0071) - (2560)(0.0080)] = -11.52 \text{ kW}$$

The net heat energy transfer q_s in the exchanger is found from Equation (5d):

$$q = q_s + q_L = 27.5 - 11.52 = 15.98 \text{ kW}$$

If the incoming outdoor air conditions had been at 35°C and 14% rh, then the net energy gained by the exhaust airstream would have been zero.

Fan Power

It is important to estimate the fan power required to move the supply and exhaust airstream through the exchanger.

The fan power P_s required by the supply air is estimated from

$$P_s = \frac{Q_s \, \Delta p_s}{\eta_f}\} \tag{8}$$

The fan power P_e required by the exhaust air is estimated from

$$P_e = \frac{Q_e \, \Delta p_e}{\eta_f} p\} \tag{9}$$

where

P_s = fan power for supply air, W
P_e = fan power for exhaust air, W
Q_s = supply volume flow rate, m^3/s
Q_e = exhaust volume flow rate, m^3/s
Δp_s = pressure drop of supply air caused by fluid friction, Pa
Δp_e = pressure drop of exhaust air caused by fluid friction, Pa
η_f = overall efficiency of fan and motor or product of fan and motor efficiencies

If pressure drops through the exchanger are not known at the operating conditions, they may be estimated from a standard pressure drop rating at a reference condition. Ideally, the density, viscosity, and Reynolds number of the air are known, which allows use of the following approach to estimate operating pressure drops.

The density and viscosity of air vary with temperature, and therefore pressure drop through the exchanger varies with temperature as well as flow rate. The variation of viscosity with temperature is given by the Sutherland law as

$$\frac{\mu}{\mu_o} = \left(\frac{T}{T_o}\right)^{3/2}\left(\frac{T_o + S}{T + S}\right) \quad (10)$$

where

μ = dynamic viscosity, kg/(m·s)
μ_o = dynamic viscosity at the reference temperature, kg/(m·s)
T = absolute temperature, K
T_o = reference temperature, K
S = constant = 110.4 K

The Reynolds number can be estimated from

$$Re_D = \frac{(\rho V)_{av} D_h}{\mu T} \quad (11)$$

where

ρ = air density, kg/m^3
V = average velocity in flow channels, m/s
D_h = hydraulic diameter of flow channels, m
μ_T = dynamic viscosity at average temperature T, kg/(m·s)

When flow through the exchanger is transitional or turbulent (i.e., when the Reynolds number Re_D for airflow through the exchanger is in the range $5 \times 10^3 \le Re_D \le 10^5$), then, treating air as an ideal gas, the pressure drop Δp at any temperature T is related to the pressure drop Δp_o at reference temperature T_o and is expressed as

$$\frac{\Delta p}{\Delta p_o} = \left(\frac{m}{m_o}\right)^{1.75}\left(\frac{T}{T_o}\right)^{1.375}\left(\frac{T_o + S}{T + S}\right)^{0.25} \quad (12)$$

where

Δp = pressure drop, Pa
Δp_o = pressure drop at reference temperature, Pa
m = mass flow rate at operating condition, kg/s
m_o = mass flow rate at rating condition, kg/s

For fully developed laminar flow through an energy exchanger, i.e. where $Re_D < 2000$, the corresponding dimensionless pressure drop relation similar to Equation (12) is given as

$$\frac{\Delta p}{\Delta p_o} = \left(\frac{m}{m_o}\right)\left(\frac{T}{T_o}\right)^{3/2}\left(\frac{1 + C/T_o}{1 + C/T}\right) \quad (13)$$

The equations above cannot be used in the case of (1) flow channels that are not reasonably smooth; (2) flow Reynolds numbers that are out of range; (3) significant exchanger fouling caused by condensation, frost, or dust; (4) excessive nonuniform property distributions inside the exchanger; or (5) significant pressure deformation of the flow channels (e.g., some plate cross-flow exchangers).

The total pumping power P of the ERV can be given as

$$P = P_s + P_e \quad (14)$$

3. TYPES OF AIR-TO-AIR HEAT EXCHANGERS

Ideal Air-to-Air Energy Exchange

An ideal air-to-air energy exchanger

- Allows temperature-driven heat transfer between participating airstreams
- Allows partial-pressure-driven moisture transfer between the two streams
- Minimizes cross-stream transfer of air, other gases (e.g., pollutants), biological contaminants, and particulates
- Optimizes energy recovery performance to minimize pressure drop while providing reasonable cost, dimensions, and mass

Heat transfer is an important energy recovery vehicle from airstreams that carry waste heat. The role of moisture transfer as an energy recovery process is less well known and merits explanation.

Consider an air-to-air energy exchanger operating in a hot, humid climate in a comfort air-conditioning application. If the energy exchanger exchanges heat but not moisture, it cools outdoor ventilation air as it passes through the exchanger to the indoor space. Heat flows from the incoming outdoor air to the outgoing (and cooler) exhaust air drawn from the indoor conditioned space. This does very little to mitigate the high humidity carried into the indoor space by the outdoor ventilation air and may even increase the relative humidity in the conditioned space, resulting in increased refrigeration and/or reheat to dehumidify the air and achieve acceptable comfort conditions. On the other hand, if the energy exchanger transfers both heat and moisture, the humid outdoor supply air transfers moisture to the less-humid inside exhaust air as the streams pass through the energy exchanger. The lower humidity of the entering ventilation air requires less energy input for comfort conditioning.

Fixed-Plate Heat Exchangers

Plate exchangers are available in many configurations, materials, sizes, and flow patterns. Many have modules that can be arranged to handle almost any airflow, effectiveness, and pressure drop requirement. Plates are formed with spacers or separators (e.g., ribs, dimples, ovals) constructed into the plates or with external separators (e.g., supports, braces, corrugations). Airstream separations are sealed by folding, multiple folding, gluing, cementing, welding, or any combination of these, depending on the application and manufacturer. Ease of access for examining and cleaning heat transfer surfaces depends on the configuration and installation.

Heat transfer resistance through the plates is small compared to the airstream boundary layer resistance on each side of the plates. Heat transfer efficiency is not substantially affected by the heat transfer coefficient of the plates. Aluminum is the most popular plate construction material because of its nonflammability and durability. Polymer plate exchangers may improve heat transfer by causing some turbulence in the channel flow, and are popular because of their corrosion resistance and cost-effectiveness. Steel alloys are used for temperatures over 200°C and for specialized applications where cost is not a key factor. Plate exchangers normally conduct sensible heat only; however, water-vapor-permeable materials, such as treated paper and microporous polymeric membranes, may be used to transfer moisture, thus providing total (enthalpy) energy exchange.

Most manufacturers offer modular plate exchangers. Modules range in capacity from 0.01 to 5 m^3/s and can be arranged into configurations exceeding 50 m^3/s. Multiple sizes and configurations allow selections to meet space and performance requirements.

Plate spacing ranges from 2.5 to 12.5 mm, depending on the design and application. Heat is transferred directly from the warm airstreams through the separating plates into the cool airstreams. Usually design, construction, and cost restrictions result in the selection of cross-flow exchangers, but additional counterflow patterns can increase heat transfer effectiveness.

Normally, both latent heat of condensation (from moisture condensed as the temperature of the warm exhaust airstream drops below its dew point) and sensible heat are conducted through the separating plates into the cool supply airstream. Thus, energy is transferred but moisture is not. Recovering 80% or more of the available waste exhaust heat is possible.

Fixed-plate heat exchangers can achieve high sensible heat recovery and total energy effectiveness because they have only a

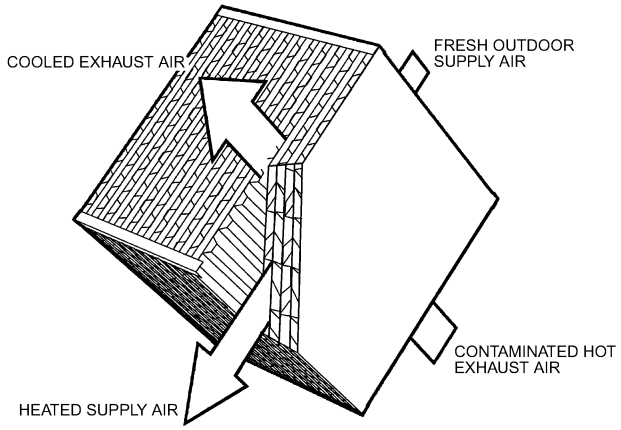

Fig. 2 Fixed-Plate Cross-Flow Heat Exchanger

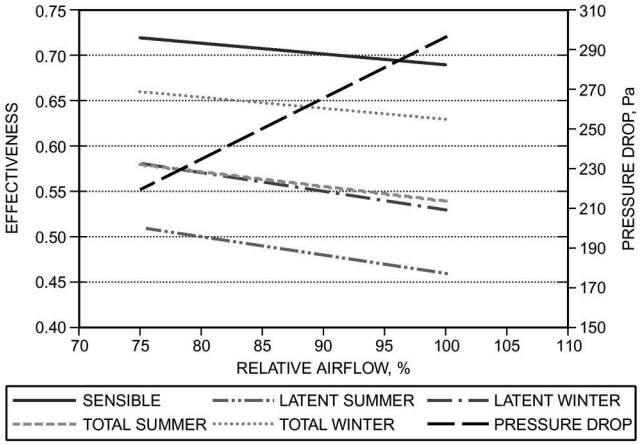

Fig. 3 Variation of Pressure Drop and Effectiveness with Airflow Rates for Membrane Plate Exchanger

(Dhamshala, 2016)

primary heat transfer surface area separating the airstreams and are therefore not inhibited by the additional secondary resistance (e.g., pumping liquid, in runaround systems or transporting a heat transfer medium) inherent in some other exchanger types. In a cross-flow arrangement (Figure 2), they usually do not have sensible effectiveness greater than 75% unless two devices are used in series as shown in Figure 3.

One advantage of the plate exchanger is that it is a static device with little or no leakage between airstreams. As velocity increases, the pressure difference between the two airstreams increases. High differential pressures may deform the separating plates and, if excessive, can permanently damage the exchanger, significantly reducing the airflow rate on the low-pressure side as well as the effectiveness and possibly causing excessive air leakage. This is not normally a problem because differential pressures in most applications are less than 1 kPa. In applications requiring high air velocities, high static pressures, or both, plate exchangers built to withstand these conditions are available and should be specified.

Most sensible plate exchangers have condensate drains, which remove condensate and also wastewater in water-wash systems. Heat recovered from a high-humidity exhaust is better returned to a building or process by a sensible heat exchanger rather than an enthalpy exchanger if humidity transfer is not desired.

Frosting can be controlled by preheating incoming supply air, bypassing part of the incoming air, recirculating supply air through the exhaust side of the exchanger, or temporarily interrupting supply air while maintaining exhaust. However, frost on cross-flow heat exchangers is less likely to block the exhaust airflow completely than with other types of exchangers. Generally, frost should be avoided unless a defrost cycle is included.

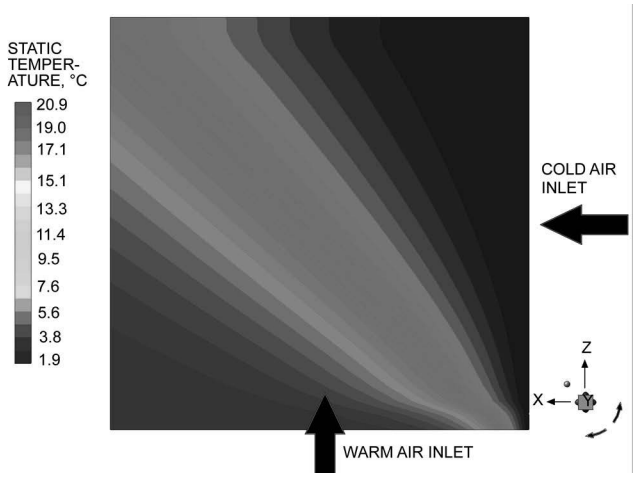

Fig. 4 Typical Temperature Stratification at Outlets of Cross-Flow Heat Exchanger

Fixed-plate heat exchangers can be made from permeable membranes designed to maximize moisture and energy transfer between airstreams while minimizing air transfer. Suitable permeable microporous membranes for this emerging technology include cellulose, polymers, and other synthetic materials such as hydrophilic electrolyte. Hydrophilic electrolytes are made from, for example, sulphonation chemistry techniques and contain charged ions that attract polar water molecules; adsorption and desorption of water occur in vapor state.

Airstreams exiting a cross-flow plate exchanger display temperature stratification when there is a temperature difference between the two airstreams (Figure 4). Enthalpy plate exchangers will also display humidity stratification. This should be considered if the temperature of one of these airstreams is to be measured (e.g., to control operation of downstream conditioning equipment or of a defrost mechanism).

Heat exchanger effectiveness depends heavily on the airflow direction and pattern of the supply and exhaust airstreams. Parallel-flow exchangers (Figure 5A), in which both airstreams move along heat exchange surfaces in the same direction, have a theoretical maximum effectiveness of 50%. Counterflow exchangers (Figure 5B), in which airstreams move in opposite directions, can have a theoretical effectiveness approaching 100%, but typical units have an effectiveness closer to 80%. Theoretical effectiveness for cross-flow heat exchangers is somewhat lower than for counterflow, and typical units have effectiveness of 50 to 70% (Figure 5C) and 60 to 85% for multiple-pass exchangers (Figure 5D).

In practice, construction limitations favor designs that use transverse flow (or cross-flow) over much of the heat exchange surface (Figures 5C and 5D).

Rotary Air-to-Air Energy Exchangers

A rotary air-to-air energy exchanger, or **rotary energy recovery wheel**, has a revolving cylinder filled with an air-permeable medium having a large internal surface area designed to absorb heat and/or moisture. Adjacent supply and exhaust airstreams each flow through half the exchanger in a counterflow pattern (Figure 6). Heat transfer media may be selected to recover sensible heat only or total (sensible plus latent) heat.

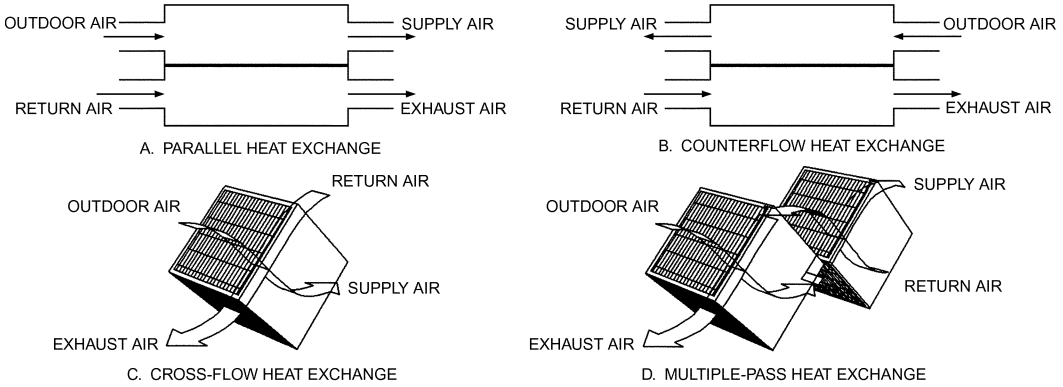

Fig. 5 Plate Heat or Heat and Mass Exchanger Airflow Configurations

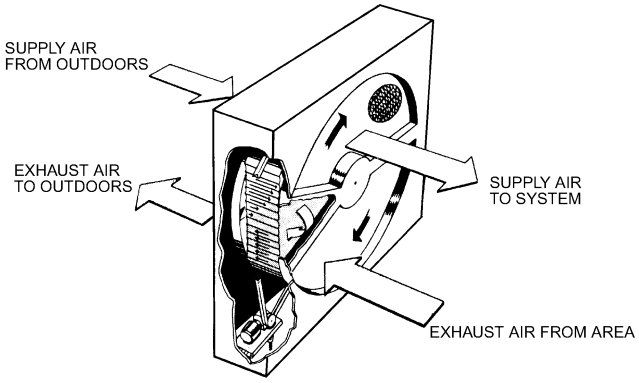

Fig. 6 Rotary Air-to-Air Energy Exchanger

Sensible Versus Enthalpy Recovery. Sensible heat is transferred as the medium stores heat from the hot airstream and releases it to the cold one. Latent heat is transferred as the medium adsorbs water vapor from the higher-humidity airstream and desorbs moisture into the lower-humidity airstream, driven in each case by the vapor pressure difference between the airstream and energy exchange medium. Thus, the moist air is dried while the drier air is humidified. In total energy transfer, both sensible and latent heat transfer occur simultaneously. Sensible-only wheels (not coated with desiccant) can also transfer moisture via a mechanism of condensation and reevaporation driven by dew point and vapor pressure; the latent effectiveness is typically lower than that of enthalpy wheels and varies strongly with conditions.

Because rotary exchangers have a counterflow configuration and normally use small-diameter flow passages, they are quite compact and can achieve high sensible or enthalpy transfer effectiveness. When compared to fixed-plate exchangers, rotary energy recovery wheels are much more compact when treating the same airflow.

Media Selection. Air contaminants, dew point, exhaust air temperature, and supply air properties influence the choice of materials for the casing, rotor structure, and medium of a rotary energy exchanger. Aluminum, steel, and polymers are the usual structural, casing, and rotor materials for normal comfort ventilating systems. Exchanger media are fabricated from metal, mineral, or synthetic materials and provide either random or directionally oriented flow through their structures.

Random-flow media are made by knitting wire into an open woven cloth or corrugated mesh, which is layered to the desired configuration. Aluminum mesh is packed in pie-shaped wheel segments. Stainless steel and monel mesh are used for high-temperature and corrosive applications. These media should only be used with clean, filtered airstreams because they plug easily. Random-flow media also require a significantly larger face area than directionally oriented media for a given airflow and pressure drop.

Directionally oriented media are available in various geometric configurations. The most common consist of small (1.5 to 2 mm) air passages parallel to the direction of airflow. Air passages are very similar in performance regardless of their shape (triangular, hexagonal, parallel plate, or other). Aluminum foil, paper, plastic, and synthetic materials are used for low and medium temperatures. Stainless steel and ceramics are used for high temperatures and corrosive atmospheres.

Media surface areas exposed to airflow vary from 300 to over 4000 m^2/m^3, depending on the type of medium and physical configuration. Media may also be classified by their ability to recover sensible heat only or total heat. Media for sensible heat recovery are made of aluminum, copper, stainless steel, and monel. Media for total heat recovery can be from any of a number of materials and treated with a desiccant (typically zeolites, molecular sieves, silica gels, activated alumina, titanium silicate, synthetic polymers, lithium chloride, or aluminum oxide) to have specific moisture recovery characteristics.

Cross-Leakage. Cross-leakage (mixing between supply and exhaust airstreams) can occur in all rotary energy exchangers by two mechanisms: carryover and seal leakage. Refer to the Air Leakage section of this chapter for more detail on these two methods of leakage and description of how to measure and rate cross-leakage.

Measures can be taken to reduce cross-leakage, though reduction may result in an energy penalty to process additional outdoor air. Cross leakage can be reduced by placing the blowers to maintain at least 125 Pa greater static pressure in the leaving supply airstream than the entering exhaust airstream, thereby promoting leakage of outdoor air to the exhaust airstream. A purge section also can be installed on the heat exchanger to reduce exhaust air leakage from carryover. A purge section is a section of wheel that directs outdoor air through the wheel and into the exhaust air outlet to remove any entrained exhaust air before rotating back into the supply airstream.

In many applications, some air recirculation due to cross-leakage is not a concern. However, critical applications such as hospital operating rooms, laboratories, and cleanrooms require stringent control of carryover. Carryover can be reduced to less than 0.1% of the exhaust airflow with a purge section but cannot be completely eliminated.

The theoretical carryover of a wheel without a purge section is directly proportional to the speed of the wheel and the void volume of the medium (75 to 95% void, depending on type and configuration). For example, a 3 m diameter, 200 mm deep wheel with a 90% void volume operating at 14 rpm has a carryover volumetric flow of

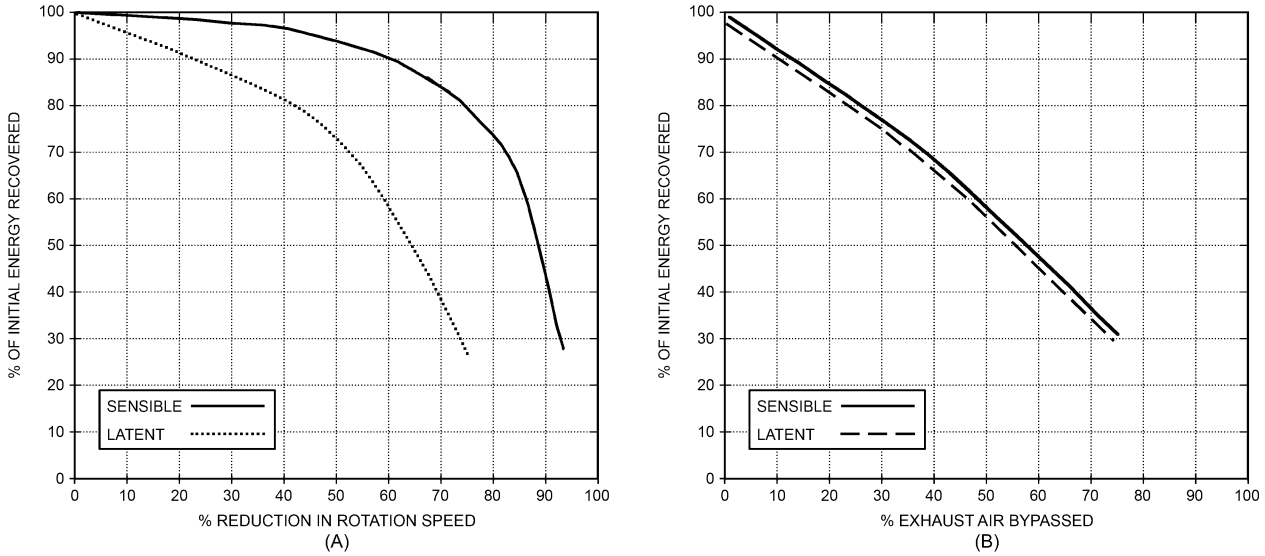

Fig. 7 Latent and Sensible Effectiveness Versus (A) Wheel Speed and (B) Bypassed Air

(Moffitt 2010)

$$\pi(3/2)^2(0.2)(0.9)(14/60) = 0.3 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$$

If the wheel is handling a 9 m^3/s balanced flow, the percentage carryover is

$$\frac{0.3}{9} \times 100 = 3.3\%$$

The exhaust fan, which is usually located at the exit of the exchanger, should be sized to include leakage and purge airflows. The supply fan should be sized to account for any outdoor air correction factor of the rotary exchanger.

Modulating Energy Recovery. Two control methods are commonly used to regulate wheel energy recovery: supply or return air bypass and variation of the wheel rotation speed. These methods may be used to limit heat exchange when it is not beneficial. See the Controls and Defrost Control sections for additional detail on specific energy recovery control measures.

In **supply** or **exhaust air bypass** control, the amount of supply air allowed to pass through the wheel establishes the supply air temperature. An air bypass damper, controlled by a wheel supply air discharge temperature sensor, regulates the proportion of supply air permitted to bypass the exchanger.

The second method regulates the energy recovery rate by varying wheel rotational speed. The most frequently used **variable-speed drives** are (1) a silicon controlled rectifier (SCR) with variable-speed dc motor, (2) a constant-speed AC motor with hysteresis coupling, and (3) an AC frequency inverter with an AC induction motor. The dehumidification capacity and reheating effectiveness of a energy wheel can be varied by changing the wheel speed (Figure 7A) or by bypassing air around the wheel (Figure 7B) (Moffitt 2010). Figure 7A is a typical capacity curve for varying the wheel's rotation speed when the outdoor air is cooler and drier than the exhaust air; when outdoor air conditions are cooler and more humid, capacity may increase at low speeds (Simonson et al. 2000).

Figure 8 shows the effectiveness ε, sensible heat transfer only, with balanced airflow, convection/conduction ratio less than 4, and no leakage or cross-flow, of a regenerative counterflow heat wheel versus number of transfer units (NTU). This simple example of a regenerative wheel also shows that regenerative counterflow rotary effectiveness increases with wheel speed (C_r is proportional to wheel speed), but there is no advantage in going beyond C_r/C_{min} = 5

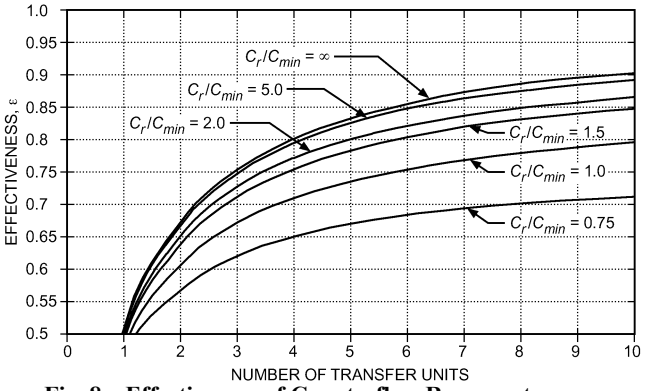

Fig. 8 Effectiveness of Counterflow Regenerator as a Function of NTU

(Shah 1981)

because the carryover of contaminants increases with wheel speed. See Kays and Crawford (1993) or Shah (1981) for details.

Rotary energy or enthalpy wheels are more complex than sensible wheels, but recent research has characterized their behavior using laboratory and field data (Johnson et al. 1998).

A dead band control, which stops or limits the exchanger, may be necessary when no recovery is desired (e.g., when outdoor air temperature is higher than the required supply air temperature but below the exhaust inlet air temperature). When outdoor air temperature is above the exhaust air temperature, the equipment operates at full capacity to cool incoming air. During very cold weather, it may be necessary to heat the supply air, stop the wheel, or, in small systems, use a defrost cycle for frost control.

Maintenance and Operation. Rotary energy recovery wheels require little maintenance and tend to be self-cleaning because the airflow direction is reversed for each rotation of the wheel. The following maintenance procedures ensure best performance:

- At commissioning of the rotary exchanger, inspect seals and set purge angle if purge section is included. Verify direction of wheel rotation.
- Clean the medium when lint, dust, or other foreign materials build up, following the manufacturer's instructions.

- Maintain drive motor and train according to the manufacturer's recommendations. Speed-control motors that have commutators and brushes require more frequent inspection and maintenance than induction motors. Brushes should be replaced, and the commutator should be periodically turned and undercut.
- Inspect wheels regularly for proper belt or chain tension. Inspect seals regularly for signs of wear and replace if necessary.
- Refer to the manufacturer's recommendations for spare and replacement parts.

Coil Energy Recovery (Runaround) Loops

A typical coil energy recovery loop (Figure 9) places extended-surface, finned-tube water coils in the supply and exhaust airstreams of a building or process. The coils are connected in a closed loop by counterflow piping through which an intermediate heat transfer fluid or a working fluid (typically water mixed with ethylene or propelyne glycol) is pumped. Coil energy recovery loops are highly flexible. The loop accommodates remote supply and exhaust ducts and allows simultaneous transfer of energy between multiple sources with zero cross contamination between airstreams. This makes them well suited to renovation, industrial applications, laboratories, and hospitals. In critical environments, the system is equipped with *N*+1 redundancy on pumps so, if one fails, the system can continue to run at 100% output.

As with other sensible recovery technologies, some means of frost control should be applied in very cold climates, to avoid condensation forming on the exhaust coil and freezing. By maintaining an exhaust leaving air temperature above freezing (e.g., 2°C) any condensation formed on the fins will not freeze. This is achieved by reducing energy recovery performance, through either reducing working fluid flow in the system (i.e., pump speed), or partially bypassing the supply coils (bypass valve). Controlling pump speeds and valve positions can also be used to maintain the supply air leaving temperature. When the system is not required to recover energy (e.g. economizer mode), then the pumps can be turned off altogether.

An expansion tank must be included to allow fluid expansion and contraction. A closed expansion tank minimizes oxidation when ethylene glycol is used.

Standard finned-tube water coils may be used; however, these need to be selected using an accurate simulation model if high effectiveness and low costs are needed (Johnson et al. 1995). Integrating runaround loops in buildings with variable loads to achieve maximum benefits may require combining the runaround simulation with building energy simulation (Dhital et al. 1995). Manufacturers' design curves and performance data should be used when selecting coils, face velocities, and pressure drops, but only when the design data are for the same temperature and operating conditions as in the runaround loop.

When testing chilled-water coils for certification, AHRI *Standard* 410 requires testing in the range of 1.7 to 12.8°C. Care should be taken when using manufacturers' selection programs for sizing coils for runaround loops. It is common to use a cooling coil design for these systems, but average water temperatures can vary outside the range for which these coils are typically used. For example, in commercial comfort conditioning, average water temperatures in a runaround loop can range from –4°C (–29°C outdoors, 21°C return) to 27°C (35°C outdoors, 24°C return) in a single application, whereas cooling coils are normally applied using a steady chilled-water supply designed from a narrower range.

The coil energy recovery loop cannot transfer moisture between airstreams; however, indirect evaporative cooling can reduce the exhaust air temperature, which significantly reduces cooling loads. For the most cost-effective operation, with equal airflow rates and no condensation, typical effectiveness values range from 45 to 65%.

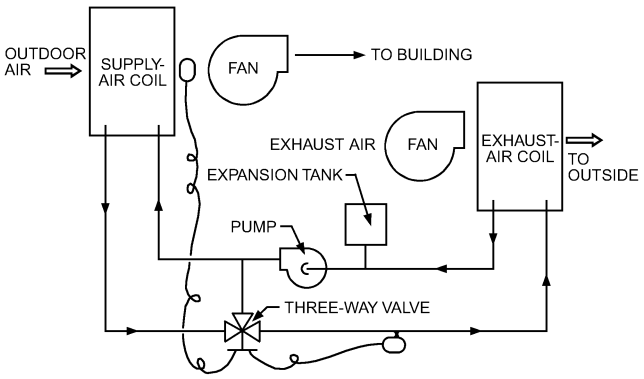

Fig. 9 Coil Energy Recovery Loop

The highest effectiveness does not necessarily give the greatest net life-cycle cost saving.

Typically, the sensible heat effectiveness of a coil energy recovery loop is independent of the outdoor air temperature. However, when the capacity is controlled, the sensible heat effectiveness decreases.

Coil energy recovery loops use coils constructed to suit their environment and operating conditions. For typical comfort-to-comfort applications, standard coil construction usually suffices. In process-to-process and process-to-comfort applications, the effect of high temperature, condensable gases, corrosives, and contaminants on the coil(s) must be considered. Above 200°C, special construction may be required to ensure a permanent fin-to-tube bond. The effects of condensable gases and other adverse factors may require special coil construction and/or coatings. Chapters 23 and 27 discuss the construction and selection of coils in more detail.

Complete separation of the airstreams eliminates cross-contamination between the supply and exhaust air.

Coil energy recovery loops require little maintenance. The only moving parts are the circulation pump and three-way control valve. However, to ensure optimum operation, the air should be filtered, the coil surface cleaned regularly, the pump and valve maintained, and the transfer fluid refilled or replaced periodically. Fluid manufacturers or their representatives should be contacted for specific recommendations.

The thermal transfer fluid selected for a closed-loop exchanger depends on the application and on the temperatures of the two airstreams. An inhibited ethylene glycol solution in water is common when freeze protection is required. These solutions break down to an acidic sludge at temperatures above 135°C. If freeze protection is needed and exhaust air temperatures exceed 135°C, a nonaqueous synthetic heat transfer fluid should be used. Heat transfer fluid manufacturers and chemical suppliers should recommend appropriate fluids.

Due to the flexibility of the runaround loop, systems can incorporate an array of features:

- Multiple airstreams with a unique supply leaving temperature set point for each airstream
- Many-to-one airstreams (e.g., many exhaust ducts to a common supply duct)
- Heat injection, where hot water or steam supplies heat to the working fluid directly, eliminating the need for hot-water coils in the air-handling unit(s) (Figure 10)
- Precool-reheat, placing two supply coils in a supply airstream, one upstream of the cooling coil and one downstream, to further improve energy recovery when dehumidification is required (Figure 11)

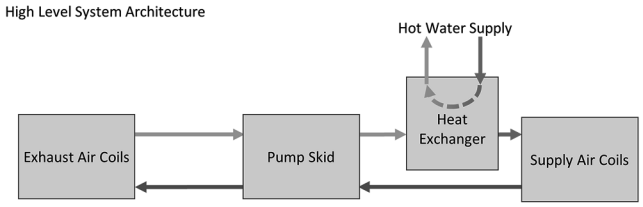

Fig. 10 Adding Supplemental Heat to the System

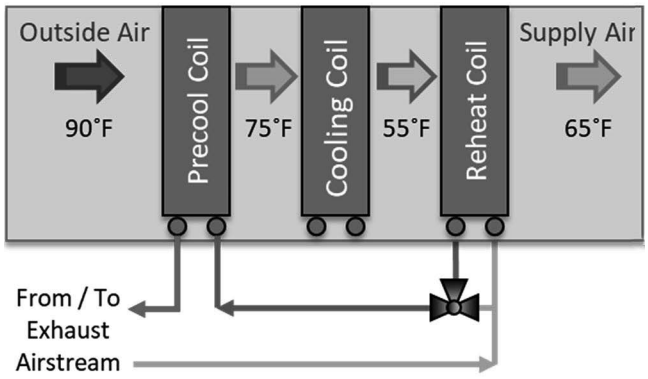

Fig. 11 Coil Energy Recovery Loop

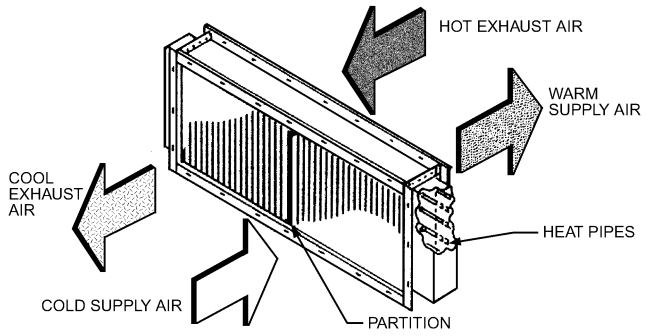

Fig. 12 Heat Pipe Assembly

Heat Pipe Heat Exchangers

Figure 12 shows a typical heat pipe assembly. Hot air flowing over the evaporator end of the heat pipe vaporizes the working fluid. A vapor pressure gradient drives the vapor to the condenser end of the heat pipe tube, where the vapor condenses, releasing the latent energy of vaporization (Figure 13). The condensed fluid is wicked or flows back to the evaporator, where it is revaporized, thus completing the cycle. Thus the heat pipe's working fluid operates in a closed-loop evaporation/condensation cycle that continues as long as there is a temperature difference to drive the process. Using this mechanism, the heat transfer rate along a heat pipe is up to 1000 times greater than through copper (Ruch 1976).

Energy transfer in heat pipes is often considered isothermal. However, there is a small temperature drop through the tube wall, wick, and fluid medium. Heat pipes have a finite heat transfer capacity that is affected by factors such as wick design, tube diameter, working fluid, and tube (heat pipe) orientation relative to horizontal. In current designs, a wick is replaced by circumferential grooves that facilitate capillary-action flow of condensed refrigerant back to the evaporator section.

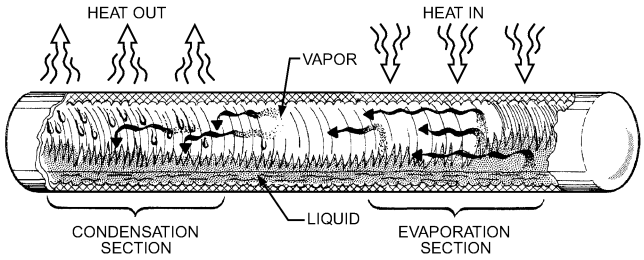

Fig. 13 Heat Pipe Operation

HVAC systems use copper or aluminum heat pipe tubes with aluminum or copper fins. Fin designs include continuous corrugated plate, continuous plain, and spiral. Modifying fin design and tube spacing changes pressure drop at a given face velocity.

For process-to-comfort applications with large temperature changes, tubes and fins are usually constructed of the same material to avoid problems with different thermal expansions of materials. Heat pipe heat exchangers for exhaust temperatures below 220°C are most often constructed with aluminum or copper tubes and fins. Protective coatings allow inexpensive aluminum to replace exotic metals in corrosive atmospheres; these coatings have a minimal effect on thermal performance.

Heat pipe heat exchangers for use above 220°C are generally constructed with steel tubes and fins. The fins are often aluminized to prevent rusting. Composite systems for special applications may be created by assembling units with different materials and/or different working fluids.

Selecting the proper working fluid for a heat pipe is critical to long-term operation. The working fluid should have high latent heat of vaporization, a high surface tension, and a low liquid viscosity over the operating range; it must be thermally stable at operating temperatures. Decomposition of the thermal fluids can form noncondensable gases that deteriorate performance. For low-temperature applications, gases such as helium can be used as working fluid; for moderate temperatures, commercial refrigerants and liquids such as water can be used; and for high temperatures, liquid metals such as sodium or mercury can be used.

Heat pipe heat exchangers typically have no cross-contamination for pressure differentials between airstreams of up to 12 kPa. A vented double-wall partition between the airstreams can provide additional protection against cross contamination. If an exhaust duct is attached to the partition space, any leakage is usually withdrawn and exhausted from the space between the two ducts. Similarly, an extended space can be created between the airstreams, where the space around the pipes is packed, or sealed, with an expanding foam.

Heat pipe heat transfer capacity depends on design and orientation. Figure 14 shows a typical effectiveness curves for various face velocities and rows of tubes. As the number of rows increases, effectiveness increases at a decreasing rate. For example, doubling the number of rows of tubes in a 60% effective heat exchanger increases the effectiveness to 75%. The effectiveness of a counterflow heat pipe heat exchanger depends on the total number of rows such that two units in series yield the same effectiveness as a single unit of the same total number of rows. Series units are often used to facilitate handling, cleaning, and maintenance. Effectiveness also depends on outdoor air temperature and the ratio of mass flow rates of the airstreams. Typically, heat capacity in the cooling season increases with a rise in outdoor air temperature. It has an opposite effect during the heating season. Effectiveness typically increases with the ratio of mass flow rates of the fluids (flow rate of the fluid with warmer entering temperature over that of cooler entering fluid temperature).

The heat transfer capacity of a heat pipe increases roughly with the square of the inside diameter of the pipe. For example, at a given tilt angle, a 25 mm inside diameter heat pipe will transfer roughly 2.5 times as much energy as a 16 mm inside diameter pipe. Consequently, heat pipes with large diameters, or tubes joined into a circuit, are used for larger-airflow applications and where level installation is required to accommodate both summer and winter operation.

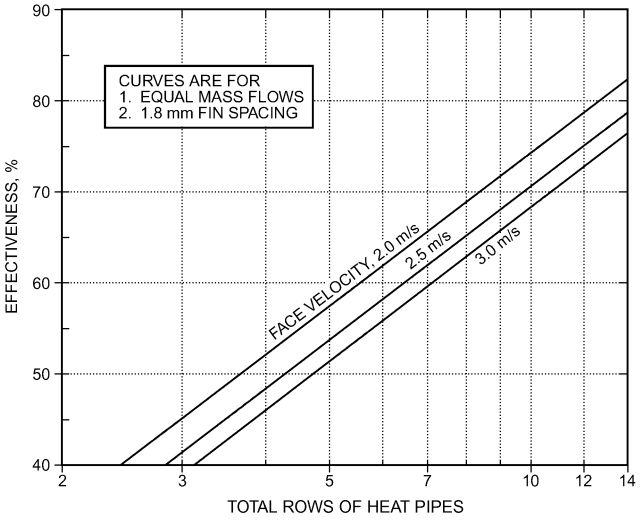

Fig. 14 Heat Pipe Exchanger Effectiveness

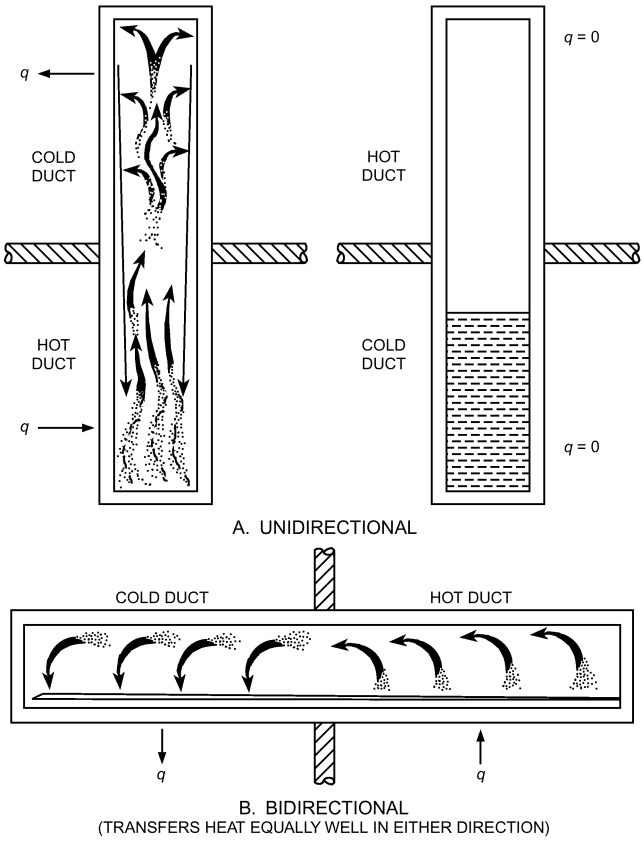

Fig. 15 Sealed-Tube Thermosiphons

Heat transfer capacity is virtually independent of heat pipe length, except for very short heat pipes. A system can be reconfigured to a taller face height and more numerous but shorter heat pipes to yield the same airflow face area while improving system performance. Also, under limiting conditions, adding rows increases performance more proportionally. In typical HVAC comfort applications, the heat pipe capacity is not reached, and longer heat pipes can be used to recover more energy. The limit for a level (two-season) 12.7 mm-diameter heat pipe, using R-410A and six rows deep, is 5080 mm in most HVAC comfort applications.

The selection of fin design and spacing should be based on the dirtiness of the two airstreams and the resulting cleaning and maintenance required. For HVAC applications, fin spacing of 1.8 to 2.3 mm is common. Wider spacing (2.5 to 3.2 mm) is usually used for industrial applications. Plate-fin heat pipe heat exchangers can easily be constructed with different fin spacing for the exhaust and supply airstreams, allowing wider fin spacing on the dirty exhaust side. This increases design flexibility where pressure drop constraints exist and also prevents deterioration of performance caused by dirt build-up on the exhaust side surface.

Changing the tilt of a heat pipe controls the amount of heat it transfers. Operating the heat pipe on a slope with the hot end below (or above) the horizontal improves (or retards) condensate flow back to the evaporator end of the heat pipe. This feature can be used to improve performance in one season over another. For example, in much of North America there is more sensible energy recovery opportunity in winter than in summer, due to both the number of hours the heat pipe is in heating mode and the difference in temperatures between outdoor air and return air.

Tilting can also be used to control heat pipe performance, by pivoting the heat pipe with an actuator around a fulcrum. This is typically not used in zero-cross-contamination applications because the airstreams are separated by a flexible interface and it is difficult to maintain an acceptable seal over years of service.

Capacity and frost control can also be achieved through bypassing airflow over the heat pipes, as for air coils. Bypassing airflow is

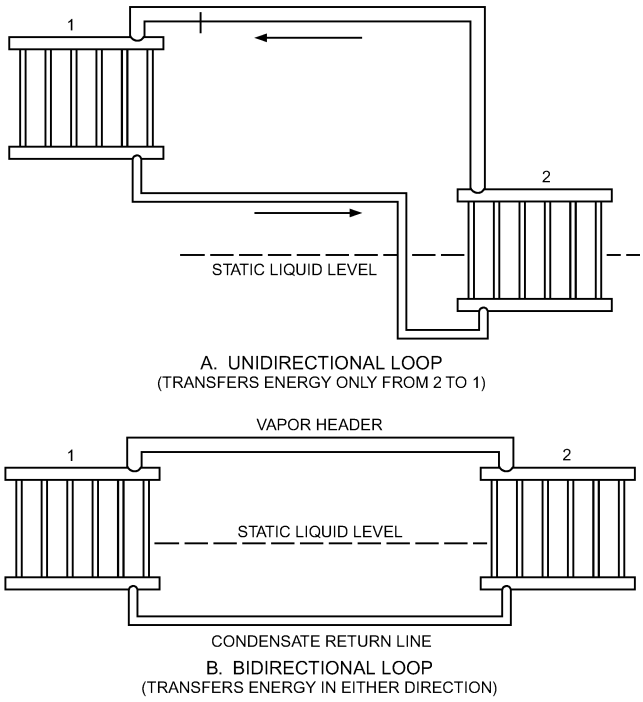

Fig. 16 Coil-Type Thermosiphon Loops

the preferred method of control in applications where the average (annual) recovery efficiency ratio (RER) is important, because the reduced airflow through the heat pipe results in reduced air pressure losses during periods of modulation.

Thermosiphon Heat Exchangers

Two-phase thermosiphon heat exchangers are sealed systems that consist of an evaporator, a condenser, interconnecting piping, and an intermediate working fluid that is present in both liquid and vapor phases. Two types of thermosiphon are used: a sealed tube (Figure 15) and a coil type (Figure 16). In the sealed-tube thermosiphon, the evaporator and the condenser are usually at opposite ends of a bundle of straight, individual thermosiphon tubes, and the exhaust and supply ducts are adjacent to each other (this arrangement is similar to that in a heat pipe system). In coil-type thermosiphons, evaporator and condenser coils are installed independently in the ducts and are interconnected by the working fluid piping (this configuration is similar to that of a coil energy recovery loop). A thermosiphon is a sealed system containing a two-phase working fluid. Because part of the system contains vapor and part contains liquid, the pressure in a thermosiphon is governed by the liquid temperature at the liquid/vapor interface. If the surroundings cause a temperature difference between the regions where liquid and vapor interfaces are present, the resulting vapor pressure difference causes vapor to flow from the warmer to the colder region. The flow is sustained by condensation in the cooler region and by evaporation in the warmer region. The condenser and evaporator must be oriented so that the condensate can return to the evaporator by gravity (Figures 15 and 16). For coil-type thermosiphon loops (Figure 16), static liquid level or refrigerant charge has a significant effect on system performance. The static charge should be optimized: a low static charge leads to dryout in the evaporator and reduced system performance, and a high charge suppresses condensation in the condenser. When the coils are on the same vertical level, as in Figure 15B, a certain amount of suppressed condensation in the condenser is inevitable because a certain static liquid head is required in the bottom of the condenser to drive liquid through the loop into the evaporator (Wei Qu 2010). Figure 17A shows a typical temperature change profile along the vertical section of a condenser, where lower ΔT indicates loss of energy recovery potential, and the thermosiphon manufacturer should quote performance as an average across the whole airstream. Wei Qu (2010) found that the condenser need not be placed much higher than the evaporator to reach full potential; Figure 17B shows that raising the condenser 25 to 30% of the coil face height above the evaporator can result in negligible variation in the temperature profile.

In thermosiphon systems, a temperature difference and gravity force are required for the working fluid to circulate between the evaporator and condenser. As a result, thermosiphons may be designed to transfer heat equally in either direction (bidirectional), in one direction only (unidirectional), or in both directions unequally. In many applications in North America, designing for both directions unequally will produce the most annual energy savings, with a focus on the heating season, where (1) there are more hours during heating and the driving difference in temperatures are greater, and (2) there is still reasonable energy recovery available in cooling mode.

Although similar in form and operation to heat pipes, thermosiphon tubes are different in two ways: (1) they have no wicks and hence rely only on gravity to return condensate to the evaporator, whereas heat pipes use capillary forces; and (2) they depend, at least initially, on nucleate boiling, whereas heat pipes vaporize the fluid from a large, ever-present liquid/vapor interface. Thus, thermosiphon heat exchangers may require a significant temperature difference to initiate boiling (Mathur and McDonald 1987; McDonald and Shivprasad 1989). Thermosiphon tubes require no pump to circulate the working fluid. However, the geometric configuration must be such that liquid working fluid is always present in the evaporator section of the heat exchanger.

Thermosiphon loops differ from other coil energy recovery loop systems in that they require no pumps and hence no external power supply, and the coils must be appropriate for evaporation and condensation. Two-phase thermosiphon loops are used for solar water heating (Mathur 1990a) and for performance enhancement of existing (i.e., retrofit applications) air-conditioning systems (Mathur 1997a, 1997b, 1997c, 1997d). Two-phase thermosiphon loops can be used to downsize new air-conditioning systems and thus reduce the overall project costs. Figures 18 and 19 shows thermosiphon loop performance (Mathur and McDonald 1986) for an eight-row, system with 2 mm fin spacing in unidirectional mode. shows the performance of the same system as a function of percent static charge for an overall temperature difference of XX. Contemporary commercial systems are designed with commercial refrigerants. Lower-pressure refrigerants, such as R-134a, are usually chosen to keep the larger-diameter transfer tubes within a safe working pressure, compared to smaller-diameter heat pipes. These systems have been designed with various working fluids like *n*-pentene and R-134a (Samba et al. 2013) with lower saturation pressures at atmospheric pressure, water (Mathur 1994) at negative operating pressures at typical ambient condition, and napthalene for high-temperature applications (Orr et al. 2016).

These energy recovery systems are available to enhance system performance (similar to heat pipe heat exchangers) of existing systems (Cieslinski and Fiuk 2013; Mathur 1994; Yau 2007) or to downsize new equipment. Using two-phase thermosiphon loop systems or other energy recovery systems can improve the overall EERs of the systems and can earn significant LEED® points. These systems are also used for exhaust heat recovery for automotive application (Orr et al. 2016) and for cooling telecommunications systems (Samba et al. 2013).

Example 2. Sensible Heat Energy Recovery in Two-Phase Thermosiphon Loop. Outdoor air at –12°C enters an eight-row. two-phase thermosiphon loop with a face area of 0.2 m at a face velocity of 2.2 m/s. Exhaust air enters the two-phase thermosiphon loop with the same velocity with same face area at _24°C. Pressure drop across the heat pipe is 0.18 kPa. The supply air density is 1.35 kg/m^3. Efficiencies of the electric motor and connected fan are 90 and 75%, respectively. Assuming the performance characteristics of the two-phase thermosiphon as shown in Figure 26, determine the sensible effectiveness $\varepsilon_{sensible}$, exit temperature of supply air to the space T_2, sensible energy recovered q_s, and power supplied to the fan motor p_s.

Solution:

From the data given, the overall temperature difference between supply and exhaust airstreams is 36 K [i.e., 24 – (–12) = 36]. From Figure 17, at face velocity of 2.2 m/s and with eight rows, the effectiveness is about 52.5%. Because the mass flow rate of the airstreams is the same, and, for simplification, assuming specific heat is constant at 1.0 kJ/(kg·K), then the exit temperature of the supply air to the space can be obtained as follows:

$$t_2 = -12 + 0.525[24 - (-12)] = 6.9°C$$

The sensible energy recovered can be obtained from a variation of Equation (5a) as

$$q_s = (2.2)(0.2)(1.35)(1.0)[6.9 - (-12)] = 11.2 \text{ kW}$$

The supply air fan power can be obtained using Equation (8) as

$$Q_s = (2.2)(0.2) = 0.44 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$$

$$P_s = [(0.44)(0.18)]/[(0.9)(0.75)] = 117 \text{ W}$$

Because there are two airstreams, the total pumping power of the two-phase thermosiphon loop (neglecting the differences in air den-

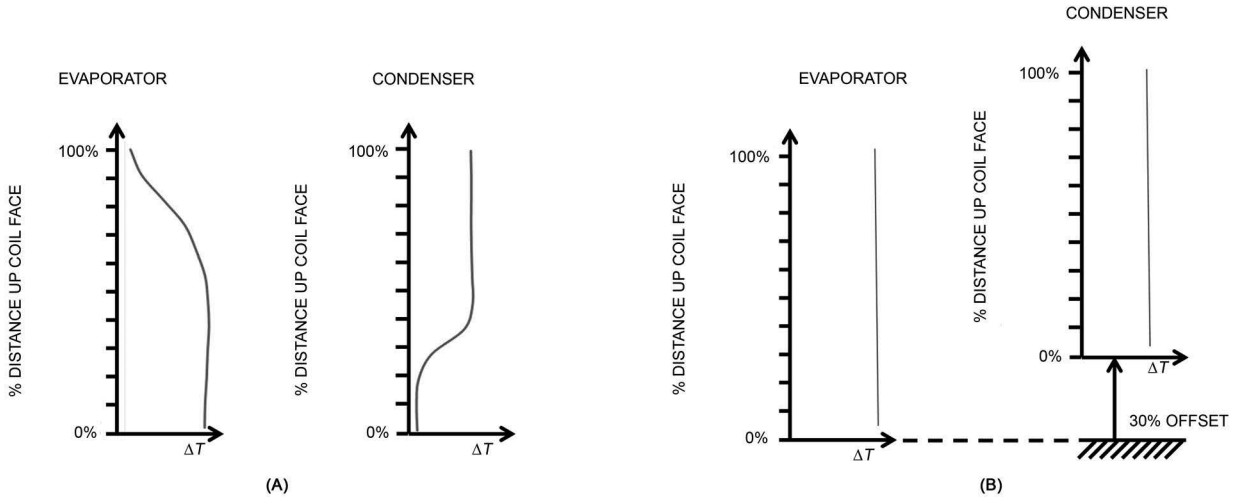

Fig. 17 Heat Recovered Across Evaporator and Condenser Coils for (A) Level Thermosiphon and (B) Thermosiphon with Elevated Condenser

sity between the airstreams) is approximately twice the value of P_s (i.e., 234 W).

Liquid-Desiccant Cooling Systems

Liquid-desiccant cooling systems (LDCSs) have great potential in reducing energy costs associated with meeting latent loads in high-occupancy commercial building applications. An LDCS can produce very dry air as long as the desiccant solution is supplied to its dehumidifier at low temperatures. However, an LDCS requires additional components: two or three plate-to-plate heat exchangers, a separate cooling tower, pump, fan, and a packed-bed humidifier and regenerator.

When exposed to moist air at the proper temperature and concentration, some chemical solutions (e.g., lithium chloride, lithium bromide, calcium chloride, triethylene glycol) can either absorb water vapor from, or release water vapor to, the airstream. These chemicals, known as liquid desiccants, are used to dehumidify air with significantly less energy consumption than by a mechanical refrigeration system. Liquid desiccants also have the advantage of removing bacteria and dust from the air compared to solid desiccant wheels or mechanical vapor compression systems. It requires a lower-temperature (less than 82°C) heat source for regeneration, which can be provided by solar energy or waste heat from local equipment. Moisture transfer between the desiccant solution and process air is caused by the difference in vapor pressures at the desiccant surface and that of the air passing over it. The desiccant collects moisture when its vapor pressure is lower than that of the water vapor in the air, and releases it when its vapor pressure is higher. Absorption of water vapor releases heat energy, including the heat of vaporization and, in some cases, additional heat. After absorbing water vapor from the processes air, the solution temperature increases slightly, and its concentration drops as absorbed water vapor becomes part of the solvent of the solution. For cyclic operation, the desiccant solution is regenerated to restore its original concentration; this involves heating the solution with a low-grade heat source and exposing the heated solution to an airstream, as shown in Figure 20 (Williams 2007). Often, outdoor air is used as a scavenging airstream in regeneration. Heat added to the desiccant solution for regeneration is of low grade and can be obtained from a source at no more than 71°C. Such low-temperature energy sources are often available as waste heat in many applications.

As seen in Figure 20, the hot, humid process air to be dehumidified enters the packed-bed dehumidifier or absorber at state 1 and leaves at state 2. The concentrated desiccant solution enters the absorber at state 5 and leaves at state 6 as dilute solution after absorbing water vapor from the process airstream. The dilute solution now passes through a liquid-to-liquid plate heat exchanger to recover some of the heat energy from the concentrated solution exiting the regenerator. The dilute solution is heated further to the required temperature in the desiccant solution heating coil and is sprayed over the incoming outdoor scavenging air passing through the regenerator. For air-to-air energy recovery purposes, the exhaust air from the space can be used for greater effectiveness in place of outdoor scavenging air. Because of the high inlet temperature of the desiccant solution, its vapor pressure is relatively higher than that of the incoming air, causing moisture transfer from the solution to the air. The inlet temperature of the desiccant solution to the regenerator for the given state of the air at state 8 is such that the desiccant concentration is restored to its value at state 6 as it exits the regenerator. The concentrated desiccant solution leaving the regenerator transfers heat energy to the incoming dilute solution exiting the packed-bed dehumidifier, in the liquid-to-liquid plate heat exchanger. Further temperature reduction of the desiccant solution, if required before it enters the absorber, can be accomplished by using cooling water from a cooling tower in the desiccant cooling coil. During extreme high-latent-load conditions, chilled water, rather than water from a cooling tower, may be necessary to cool the desiccant solution before it enters the absorber. The temperature of the solution at the inlet of the absorber strongly influences the air-dehumidifying capacity. The higher the concentration and lower the temperature of the solution, the higher the moisture absorbed and lower the humidity of the exiting air from the absorber.

Types of Desiccant Solutions. Desiccant solutions used by different investigators, as well as their key features, are shown in Table 2. Lithium chloride (LiCl) is a good candidate material because it has good desiccant characteristics and does not vaporize in air at ambient temperature, but it is corrosive. Calcium chloride ($CaCl_2$) is an equally good candidate for desiccant choice and is less expensive than LiCl. A 50%/50% combination of LiCl and $CaCl_2$ is also being investigated. Triethylene glycol (TEG) has a low vapor pressure that enables effective dehumidification in the absorber, but it also makes it vulnerable to evaporation. Special coatings may be

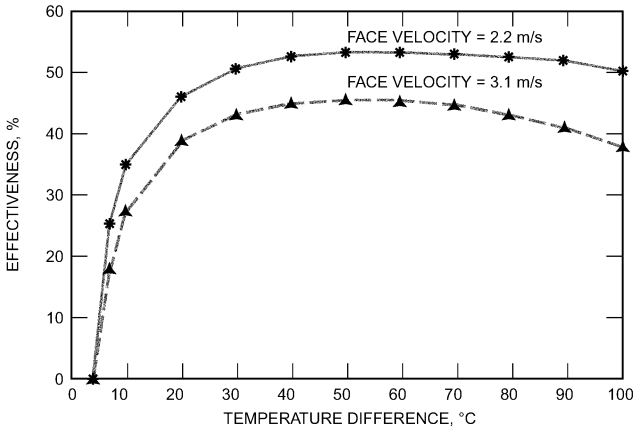

Fig. 18 Eight-Row, Unidirectional System with 2 mm Fin Spacing; Static Charge of 80%

(Mathur and McDonald 1986)

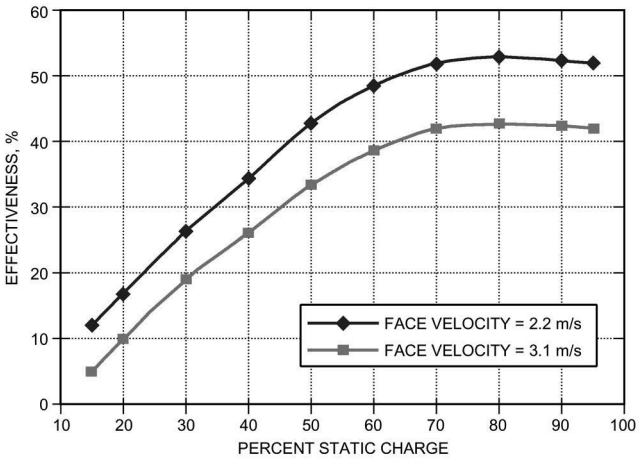

Fig. 19 Typical Performance of Two-Phase Thermosiphon Loop as Function of Percent Static Charge: Eight Rows, Unidirectional System with 2 mm Fin Spacing; Overall Temperature Difference of 35 K

(Mathur and McDonald 1986)

required to avoid corrosion, and efficient absorber design may be needed to prevent liquid or desiccant carryover.

Fluid Flow Configuration. Four different types of fluid flow configurations are used by different investigators in the packed beds for absorbers and regenerators.

- Counter flow
- Parallel flow
- Cross flow
- Falling film

Most applications are counter flow, because it provides the maximum enthalpy and humidity effectiveness for the packed beds.

Types of Packing. Packing arrangements are basically either structured or random types. In some cases, vertical surfaces or tubes are used, over which the desiccant solution falls as a thin film. The purpose of packing is to provide the maximum surface area for the desiccant solution to come in contact with the process air. The greater the area, the greater the dehumidification. The main parameters affecting bed arrangement are the enhancement of heat and mass transfer, air pressure drop, and pumping power to circulate the fluids through the bed. The main advantage of structured packing is the low pressure drop, whereas that of random packing is high heat and mass transfer but with high pressure drop. Packing compactness is typically expressed in terms of packing density a_t, in units of m^2/m^3. Typically, packing densities exceeding 200 m^2/m^3 have been achieved in the field. A higher packing density allows for more dehumidification but also produces greater pressure drop for the fluid streams. In random packing arrangements, packing is made up of Berl saddles, Raschig rings, and saddles of various trademarked designs, whereas in structured packing, the packing consists of cellulose rigid media pads, wood grids, expanded metal lash packing, or double spiral rings.

Table 2 Types of Liquid-Desiccant Solutions

Desiccant Type	Typical Concentration Range, %	Operating Temperatures, °C
LiCl	34 to 43	25 to 27
TEG	92 to 98	20.2 to 45.5
LiBr	42.6 to 57	20.1 to 34.1
$CaCl_2$	40 to 43	27.0
KCOOH	72.8 to 74	21.9 to 24.8

Source: Jain and Bansal (2007).

Twin-Tower Enthalpy Recovery Loops

One method of ventilation air enthalpy recovery is liquid desiccant twin-tower systems. In this air-to-liquid, liquid-to-air enthalpy recovery system, sorbent liquid circulates continuously between supply and exhaust airstreams, alternately contacting both airstreams directly in contactor towers (Figure 21). This liquid transports water vapor and heat. The sorbent solution is usually a halogen salt solution such as lithium chloride, calcium chloride, and water. Pumps circulate the solution between supply and exhaust contactor towers.

Both vertical and horizontal airflow contactor towers are available, and both types can be combined in a common system. Contactor towers of both configurations are commonly available with airflow capacities of up to 40 m^3/s.

In the vertical configuration, the supply or exhaust air passes vertically through the contact surface counterflow to the sorbent liquid to achieve high contact efficiency. In the horizontal configuration, air passes horizontally through the contact surface cross flow to the sorbent liquid, yielding a slightly lower contact efficiency.

The contactor surface is usually made of nonmetallic materials. Air leaving the contactor tower passes through demister pads, which remove any entrained sorbent solution. The halogen salt solution does not offgas or vaporize.

Design Considerations. Twin-tower enthalpy recovery systems operate primarily in the comfort conditioning range; they are not suitable for high-temperature applications. During summer, these systems operate efficiently with building supply outdoor air temperatures as high as 46°C. Winter supply air temperatures as low as –40°C can be tolerated without freezing or frosting problems because the sorbent solution is an effective antifreeze at all useful concentrations. During weather conditions that are not advantageous for energy recovery, the system automatically shuts down the pump(s), thereby saving operating power. When outdoor conditions warrant energy recovery, the system restarts automatically. Because contactor supply and exhaust air towers are independent units connected only by piping, supply and exhaust air fans can be located wherever desired. Contactor towers can operate with air inlet static pressure from –1.5 to 1.5 kPa, but require less than 0.4 kPa air-side pressure drop. The exhaust contactor tower may operate at a higher internal static pressure than the supply contactor tower without danger of exhaust-to-supply cross contamination.

Particulate cross contamination does not occur because wetted particulates remain in the sorbent solution until they are filtered. Limited gaseous cross contamination may occur, depending on the

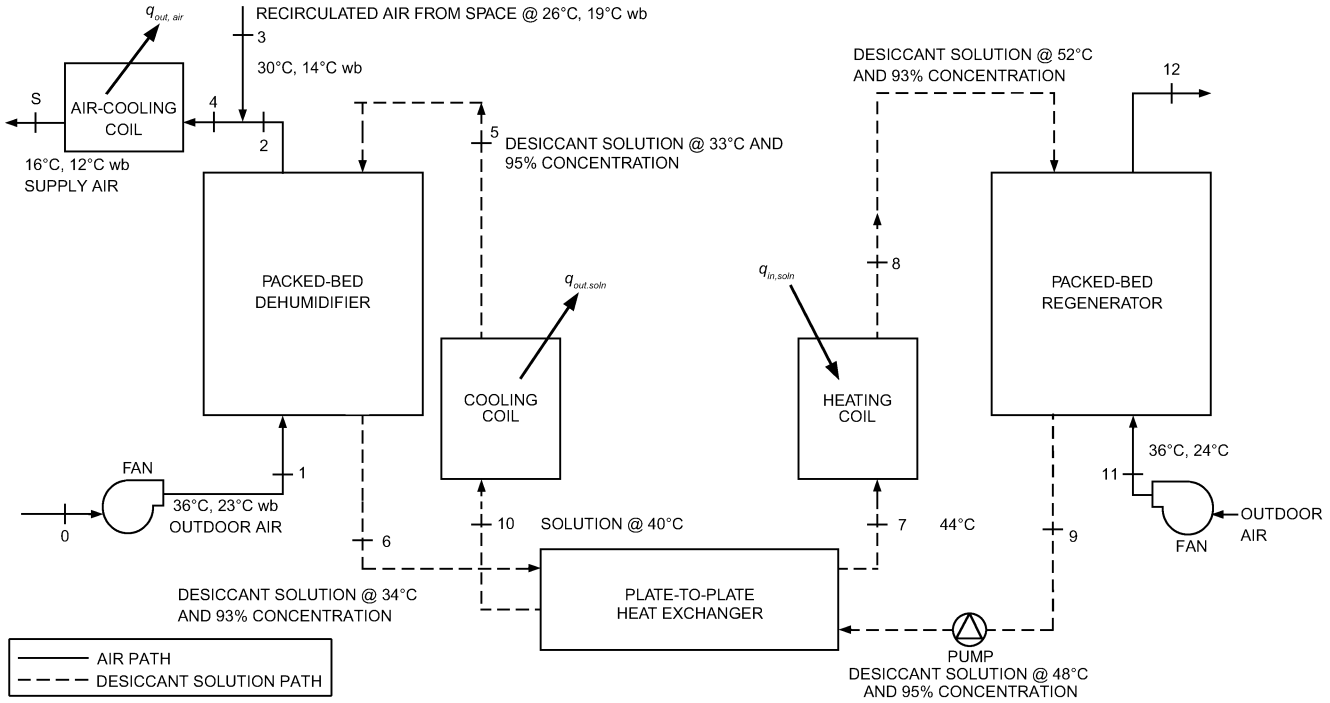

Fig. 20 Typical Dehumidification of Outdoor Air by Liquid-Desiccant System

(Williams 2007)

solubility of the gas in the sorbent solution. Sorbent solutions, especially halide brines, are bactericidal. Lithium or calcium chloride as used in twin-tower systems is viricidal against all viruses.

If the building or process exhaust contains large amounts of lint, animal hair, or other solids, filters should be placed upstream of the exhaust air contactor tower; if it contains large amounts of gaseous contaminants, such as chemical fumes and hydrocarbons, investigate the possibility of cross contamination as well as the possible effects of contaminants on the sorbent solution. When using twin-tower systems in controlled-humidity applications in colder climates, saturation effects (which can cause condensation, frosting, and icing in other types of equipment) may overdilute the twin towers' sorbent solution. Heating the sorbent liquid supplied to the supply air contactor tower can prevent dilution, as shown in Figure 21A. Heating raises the discharge temperature and humidity of air leaving the supply contactor tower, thus balancing the humidity of the system and preventing overdilution.

A thermostat sensing the leaving air temperature from the supply air contactor tower is commonly used to control the solution heater to deliver constant-temperature air regardless of outdoor temperature. Automatic addition of makeup water to maintain a fixed concentration of the sorbent solution enables the twin-tower system to deliver supply air at fixed humidity during cold weather. Thus, the system provides a constant supply air temperature and humidity without preheat or reheat coils or humidifiers.

Any number of supply air towers can be combined with any number of exhaust air towers, as shown in Figure 21B. If a sufficient elevation difference exists between supply and exhaust towers, gravity may be used to return the sorbent solution from the upper tower(s) in lieu of pumped flow. Twin-tower energy recovery systems can be retrofitted to existing buildings. The towers are connected to each other with piping. The solution piping can be easily installed inside or outside the building. Twin-tower enthalpy recovery systems operate with only routine maintenance. Complete instructions on procedures as well as spare-parts lists are included in operating manuals relevant to each installation. Periodically, the circulation pumps, spray nozzles, liquid transfer controls, and mist eliminators need checking and adjusting or maintenance. Halide brine solutions are normally used as energy transfer media in twin-tower systems. Manufacturers provide technical support, including solution sampling services to monitor and report changes in concentration and pH, thus ensuring continued maximum performance.

Fixed-Bed Regenerators

Fixed-bed regenerators (FBRs) are available in many configurations, sizes, and airflow patterns. In general, FBRs contain one or two cores for the purpose of energy transfer, and some means of reversing airflow through its core(s) to alternately store and release energy.

In North America, double-core FBRs are more common; single-core FBRs are available but have not been widely adopted. Double-core FBRs are packaged with two cores and an airflow control module to alternate supply and exhaust air through each core. These units are used in large residential, commercial, and industrial applications with airflow capacity in the range of 0.025 to 50 m^3/s. Cost and physical size are the main barriers between double-core FBRs and the residential home market.

Unlike other energy recovery exchangers, in FBRs the outlet air temperatures and humidities are never steady state; instead, they rise and fall cyclically with each reversal of airflow. This poses challenges to test facilities, which generally seek to take measurement only when the device under test is operating in steady state with very small variations in outlet conditions. The latest edition of ASHRAE *Standard* 84 introduces techniques for data reduction and humidity averaging to deal with this challenge. As more manufacturers enter the market, certified performance data may become available.

Arrangement. Cores are typically split into smaller cells (Figure 22) to facilitate transportation, handling, and cleaning. Plates are formed with spacers (e.g., ribs or dimples) constructed into the

plates or by alternating corrugation angle between adjacent plates (direction of the angle spaces plates apart). Corrugation patterns and plate thickness varies depending on manufacturer. Plate spacing ranges from 2.5 to 13 mm. Aluminum cores are the most popular construction, but some manufacturers also offer polypropylene cores for corrosive or lightweight applications.

Airflow control modules consist of a single deflector plate or a multiblade damper system. Early designs included pneumatic actuators controlled by solenoids and flow valves. Electric actuators were introduced to improve synchronization and to reduce switchover time of multiblade dampers to 0.5 to 1.5 s. Rapid switchover is of key importance to minimize exhaust air transfer between recovery periods.

In Europe, various types of single-core devices are used for residential, apartment, condo, or renovation projects with limited ceiling space. Often, the only option is a room-based decentralized ductless ventilation system, which consists of several single-core FBRs installed in the exterior walls of a space. The individual devices are synchronized via interconnecting wiring or wireless communication to alternately store and release energy from a single honeycomb-shaped, ceramic core.

Operation. Typically, the devices are staggered so half of the ventilation system is exhausting while the other half is bringing tempered outside air into the space. After a certain period of time, called the recovery period, the system switches direction to recharge the devices that have been in the outside airstream. The other half of the system now transfers energy to the outside air stream until the next recovery period.

Many single-core FBRs are equipped with a relatively small fan, capable of changing its direction at the end of each recovery period to supply air to, or exhaust air from, the space. Depending on the manufacturer, the device is designed with two opposite fans in adjacent channels, airflow deflectors, and/or backdraft flaps to alternate exhaust and supply air through the core. Performance curves of the fan must be considered for high-rise buildings and locations with high winds. Stack effect and wind direction can be detrimental to supply airflow rate or effectiveness of single-core FBRs (Figure 23).

Recovery periods in the range of 50 to 70 s are common to both single-core and double-core FBRs. Manufacturers report sensible effectiveness typically in the range of 80 to 90%. Latent recovery is also possible. With sensible-only FBRs, latent recovery can occur in condensing conditions (i.e., heating mode). FBRs also can be manufactured with desiccant treatment providing latent recovery in all conditions. Manufacturers report latent effectiveness in desiccant-treated FBRs in the 60 to 80% range, and in non-desiccant-treated FBRs, as high as 70% (depending on conditions). Longer recovery periods up to 3 h are used for free cooling mode. Some manufacturers vary the recovery period between 20 to 120 s to control discharge air temperature and/or humidity. Shorter recovery periods improve effectiveness, but the drawback is a higher exhaust air transfer ratio (Figure 24).

Exhaust air transfer for outdoor double-core FBRs is reported by manufacturers to be in the range of 3 to 5%. Indoor applications with long ducts connecting the unit to the ambient suffer from higher exhaust transfer rates due to the volume of exhaust air drawn

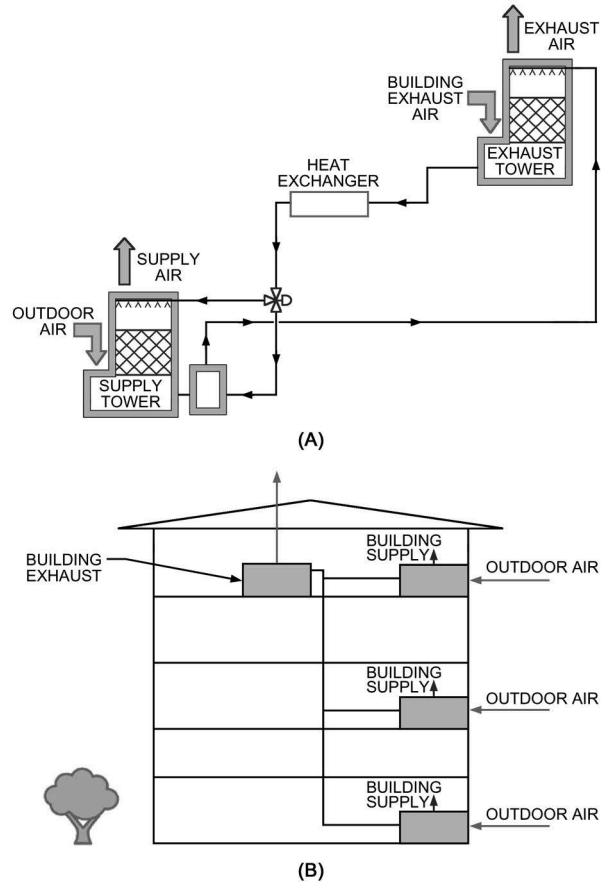

Fig. 21 Twin-Tower System Performing Indirect Evaporative Air Cooling: (A) Schematic and (B) Installation in Building

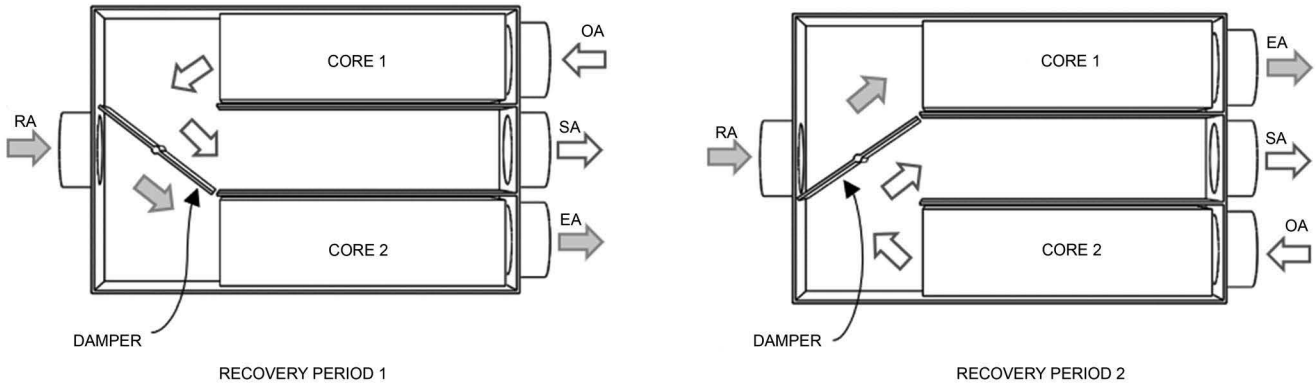

Fig. 22 Double-Core Fixed-Bed Regenerators

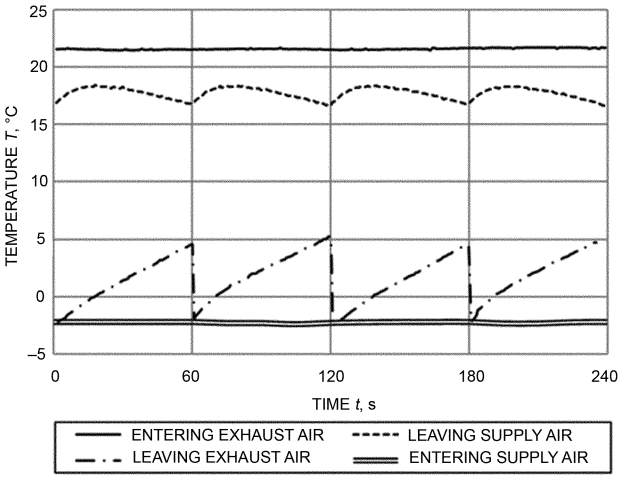

Fig. 23 Typical Temperature Profile of Fixed-Bed Regenerator Operating at 60 s Recovery Periods

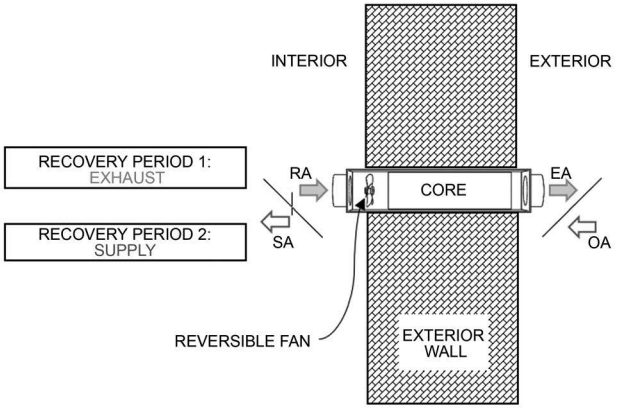

Fig. 24 Single-Core Fixed-Bed Regenerator

back from these ducts. Generally, duct length is kept under 8 m to limit increase in pressure drop and exhaust air transfer.

An advantage of FBRs is the repeated exhaust regeneration, which allows this technology to operate in extremely cold climates below –40°C without the need of auxiliary defrost strategies. Typically, discharge air from a double-core FBR is condition by a heater, or an interlocked air handling unit before entering the space.

4. PERFORMANCE RATINGS

Performance ratings should be based on tests performed in qualified laboratories that are staffed and instrumented to meet requirements of ASHRAE *Standard* 84 and AHRI *Standard* 1061.It may be very difficult to adhere to any standard when field tests are made.

Performance Ratings for Air-to-Air Heat or Heat and Mass Exchangers

ASHRAE *Standard* 84 (1) establishes a uniform method of testing for obtaining performance data; (2) specifies the data required, calculations to be used, and reporting procedures for testing each of seven independent performance factors and their uncertainty limits; and (3) guides selection of test equipment. The independent performance factors are sensible, latent, and total effectivenesses e_s, e_l, and e_t; the enthalpy recovery ratio; supply and exhaust air pressure drops ΔP_s and ΔP_e; exhaust air transfer ratio (EATR), which characterizes the fraction of exhaust air transferred to the supply air; and outdoor air correction factor (OACF), which is the ratio of supply inlet to outlet airflow. An additional useful parameter, which can be evaluated only when fan efficiency is known or assumed, is the recovery efficiency ratio.

AHRI *Standard* 1061 is an industry-established standard for rating air-to-air heat/energy exchanger performance for use in energy recovery ventilation equipment. This standard, based on ASHRAE *Standard* 84, establishes definitions, requirements for marking and nameplate data, and conformance conditions intended for the industry, including manufacturers, engineers, installers, contractors, and users. Standard temperature and humidity conditions at which equipment tests are to be conducted are specified for summer and winter conditions. Published ratings must be reported for the performance factors specified in ASHRAE *Standard* 84. The AHRI certification program using *Standard* 1061 is used to verify ratings published by manufacturers. At this time the scope of the certification program includes plate, rotary, and heat pipe exchangers. Coil energy recovery systems, twin-tower enthalpy recovery loops, and fixed-bed regenerators are not in the scope of the certification program.

Before 2020, AHRI *Standard* 1060 required the publication of ratings based on performance of the rated exchanger at two balanced airflow rates selected by the manufacturer, at standard winter and summer conditions:

Winter: Outdoor air at $t_1 = 1.7°C$ and $t_{w1} = 0.6°C$
Indoor (room) air at $t_3 = 21.1°C$ and $t_{w3} = 14.4°C$ and $p_2 - p_3 = 0$

Summer: Outdoor air at $t_1 = 35°C$ and $t_{w1} = 25.6°C$
Indoor (room) air at $t_3 = 23.9°C$ and $t_{w3} = 17.2°C$ and $p_2 - p_3 = 0$

These ratings applied to operation with the static pressure at supply air outlet equal to the static pressure at the exhaust air inlet. Ratings for the leakage metrics EATR and OACF also were to be provided at these static pressure conditions, as well as at two additional static pressure conditions selected by the manufacturer.

As of 2020, the AHRI certification program verifies ratings generated by a manufacturer's prediction software across a broad psychrometric range, at any combination of airflows and static pressures supported by the software. The program also verifies that all of the ratings required for a complete characterization of exchanger performance are provided.

Some metrics can be provided optionally. The new **energy recovery ratio** (Equation [3]) is used to characterize the performance of the exchanger in relation to its use in a system. This metric is important because, as of 2019, ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 requires that energy recovery systems have an enthalpy recovery ratio of at least 50% (i.e., a change in enthalpy of outdoor air supply equal to 50% of the difference between outdoor air and entering exhaust air enthalpies at design conditions).

Standard 90.1 previously used 50% effectiveness at design conditions, but this metric measures performance of the exchanger and is less relevant when defining the performance of an enthalpy recovery system.

It is more difficult to measure performance of a heat or heat/mass exchanger when condensation occurs. ASHRAE *Standard* 84 provides theoretical approaches, but in practice it is challenging to measure the rate at which condensate is generated, which is required to confirm the test meets steady-state requirements. CSA *Standard* C439-2018 provides a method to measure some energy and ventilation parameters of a complete ventilating unit equipped with heat or heat and mass recovery and active frost prevention or recovery means. However, this is intended for use with packaged ventilating units, and is not intended to characterize the conditions under which frost occurs in the exchanger itself.

Performance Ratings for Residential Ventilators with Air-to-Air Heat or Heat and Mass Exchangers

Residential ventilation products are certified by the Home Ventilating Institute (HVI 2015). Heat recovery ventilators and energy recovery ventilators (H/ERVs) are certified for their ventilation performance at high speed and for their energy recovery performance at manufacturer's selected airflows. The *HVI Certified Products Directory* (www.hvi.org/proddirectory) is useful for comparing product performance on a level playing field. H/ERVs must be tested at prescribed conditions in accordance with CSA *Standard* C439 at an HVI-designated laboratory to be eligible for HVI certification.

HVI issues certified ratings for H/ERVs for airflow (net supply, gross exhaust, gross supply) and for energy recovery performance parameters include the following:

- Sensible recovery efficiency (SRE)
- Adjusted sensible recovery efficiency (ASRE)
- Total sensible recovery efficiency (TRE) in cooling modes
- Adjusted total sensible recovery efficiency (ATRE) in cooling modes
- Latent recovery moisture transfer
- Very-low-temperature ventilation reductions

Note that ratings for ASRE are to be used in energy-modeling software where fan power is a separate modeling input, to avoid counting fan power twice. Residential H/ERVs are certified as a packaged unit, whereas larger commercial H/ERVs typically carry certified ratings for energy recovery performance of just the core. Products must be listed in the online directory to be considered HVI certified (i.e., not listed means not certified).

5. ADDITIONAL TECHNICAL CONSIDERATIONS

The rated effectiveness of energy recovery units is obtained under balanced flow conditions (i.e., the flow rates of supply and exhaust airstreams are the same). However, these ideal conditions do not always exist, because of design for positive building pressure, air leakage, fouling, condensation, or frosting, and the following other factors.

Air Leakage

Air leakage refers to any air that enters or leaves the supply or exhaust airstreams. Zero air leakage in either airstream would require m_1 to equal m_2 and m_3 to equal m_4. External air leakage occurs when the ambient air surrounding the energy recovery system leaks into (or exits) either or both airstreams. Internal air leakage occurs when holes or passages are open to the other airstream. Internal air leakage occurs when heat or energy exchanger design allows (1) tangential air movement in the wheel's rotational direction and (2) air movement through holes in the barrier between airstreams. Under some pressure differentials, air leaks in and out of each airstream in nearly equal amounts, giving the illusion that there is no air leakage. Heat and water vapor transfer could appear to be greater than it is in reality.

Leakage varies with heat exchanger type and design, airstream static pressure differences, and the physical condition of the heat exchanger (see Table 3). Air leakage is seldom zero because external and internal air pressures are usually different, causing air to leak from areas of higher pressure to those of lower pressure. Cross-leakage, cross-contamination, or mixing between supply and exhaust airstreams may occur in air-to-air heat exchangers and may be a significant problem if exhaust gases are toxic or odorous.

Cross-leakage between incoming fresh air and outgoing exhaust air can be classified into two mechanisms: seal leakage and carryover.

Cross-leakage is caused primarily by difference in static pressures between states 2 and 3 and/or between states 1 and 4, as shown in Figure 25. This is a major cause of cross-leakage, and underscores the importance of specifying precise locations for fans that circulate the airstreams. Seal leakage can also be caused by factors such as provisions for surging, geometrical irregularities, and local velocity distribution of the airstreams.

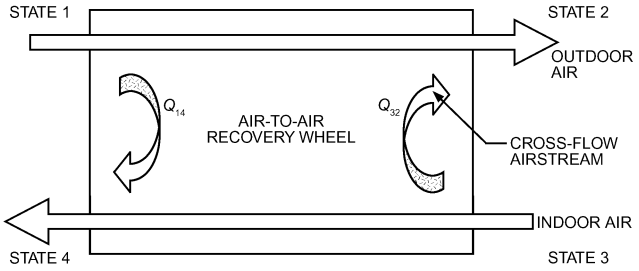

Fig. 25 Air Leakage in Energy Recovery Units

Carryover occurs in rotary recovery units because of wheel rotation out of one airstream into the other. Exhaust air trapped in cavities in the heat transfer medium is carried into the fresh airstream by the wheel's rotation. Inclusion of a purge section in a rotary energy recovery device is the best way to minimize cross-leakage due to carryover.

The test estimate of the air leakage is characterized by two dimensionless parameters: the exhaust air transfer ratio (EATR) and outdoor air correction factor (OACF). During these tests, $m_2 = m_3$, while an inert tracer gas is introduced at station 3 (Shang et al. 2001a):

$$\text{EATR} = \frac{c_2 - c_1}{c_3 - c_1} \tag{15}$$

where c_1, c_2, and c_3 are the concentrations of inert gas at states 1, 2, and 3, respectively.

EATR is the ratio of the concentration increase in supply air relative to the maximum concentration difference between stations 3 and 1. It is representative of the air mass leakage from exhaust air into supply air, when the air-to-air heat exchanger is operating at mass flow rates and static pressures equal to those at which the device was tested.

$$\text{OACF} = \frac{m_1}{m_2} \tag{16}$$

where m_1 and m_2 are the mass flow rates of incoming fresh airstream at states 1 and 2, respectively.

OACF gives the ratio of outdoor airflow required at the inlet (station 1) relative to the supply flow at 2 to compensate for air that leaks into or out of the exchanger, to meet the required net supply airflow to the building space, when the air-to-air heat exchanger is operating at mass flow rates and static pressures equal to those at which the device was tested.

Ideal operating conditions exist when there is no air leakage between the streams, EATR is close to zero, and OACF approaches 1. Deviations from ideal conditions indicate air leakage between the airstreams, which complicates the determination of accurate values for pressure drop and effectiveness. Methods to estimate actual flow rates at states 1, 2, 3, and 4 when air leakage exists and the values of the parameters EATR and OACF are known are discussed in Friedlander (2003) and Moffitt (2003). EATR and OACF must be determined when evaluating any HRV or ERV in which leakage between airstreams occurs, when evaluating the actual flow rate of outdoor

air supplied for a given ventilation requirement, and when estimating the capacity of ventilator fans, as shown by the following.

Air Capacity of Ventilator Fans

For a given ventilation requirement Q_v, the density-corrected volume flow rate capacity Q_{fan} of the supply fan is greater than Q_2 if air leakage exists (see Figure 25).

In the following calculations, be sure to obtain the value for EATR that applies to the device when it operates at the airflow volumes and static pressure that will exist in the specific application. The leakage flow rate from the exhaust to the supply air $Q_{3\text{-}2}$ can be estimated by the equation.

$$Q_3 - Q_2 = Q_2 \frac{\text{EATR}}{100} \tag{17}$$

If the ventilation requirement is Q_v, then the actual volume flow rate of supply air to the space is calculated as

$$Q_2 = Q_v + Q_{3-2} = Q_v + Q_2 \frac{\text{EATR}}{100} \tag{18}$$

This can be simplified as

$$Q_2 = \frac{Q_v}{1 - (\text{EATR}/100)} \tag{19}$$

which gives the quantity of air entering the space. Assuming steady-state conditions, and balanced flow through the energy recovery ventilator, the density corrected quantity of air leaving the building space (Q_3) should be same as air supplied to the space Q_2.

$$Q_3 = Q_2 = \frac{Q_v}{1 - (\text{EATR}/100)} \tag{20}$$

Combining Equations (16) and (20) gives the required supply air inlet volume q_1 as

$$Q_1 = Q_2(\text{OACF}) = \frac{Q_v(OACF)}{1 - (\text{EATR}/100)} \tag{21}$$

Caution should be used with Equations (20) and (21) because in many practical applications, Q_2 is not equal to Q_3.

Equation (21) gives the volume flow rate capacity of the intake, which equals the exhaust outlet for balanced airflow. (Fan capacity depends on location. This statement only applies to the supply fan at station 1 [blow-through]; its capacity would change at station 2 [draw-through].)

Pressure Drop

Pressure drop for each airstream through an energy recovery unit depends on many factors, including exchanger design, mass flow rate, temperature, moisture, and inlet and outlet air connections. The pressure drop must be overcome by fans or blowers. Because the power required for circulating airstreams through the recovery unit is directly proportional to the pressure drop, the pressure drop through the energy recovery unit at its operating conditions should be known. The pressure drop may be used with the fan efficiency to characterize the energy used by the exchanger and in turn the efficiency (not effectiveness) of an application.

Maintenance

The method used to clean a heat exchanger depends on the transfer medium or mechanism used in the energy recovery unit and on the nature of the material to be removed. Grease build-up from kitchen exhaust, for example, is often removed with an automatic water-wash system. Other kinds of dirt may be removed by vacuuming, blowing compressed air through the passages, steam cleaning, manual spray cleaning, soaking the units in soapy water or solvents, or using soot blowers. The cleaning method should be determined during design so that a compatible heat exchanger can be selected.

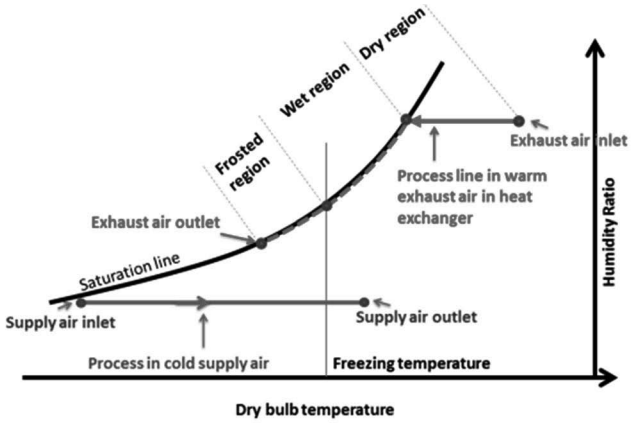

Fig. 26 Psychrometric Chart Showing the Processes in Exhaust and Supply Airstreams in Heat Exchangers

Cleaning frequency depends on the quality of the exhaust airstream. Residential and commercial HVAC systems generally require only infrequent cleaning; industrial systems, usually more. Consult equipment suppliers about the specific cleaning and maintenance requirements of systems being considered.

Filtration

Filters are recommended and should be placed in both the supply and exhaust airstreams to reduce fouling and thus the frequency of cleaning. Exhaust filters are especially important if the contaminants are sticky or greasy or if particulates can plug airflow passages in the exchanger. Supply filters eliminate insects, leaves, and other foreign materials, thus protecting both the heat exchanger and air-conditioning equipment. Snow or frost can block the air supply filter and cause severe problems. Specify steps to ensure a continuous flow of supply air.

Controls

Heat exchanger controls may control frost formation or regulate the amount of energy transferred between airstreams at specified operating conditions. For example, ventilation systems designed to maintain specific indoor conditions at extreme outdoor design conditions may require energy recovery modulation to provide an economizer function, to prevent overheating ventilation supply air during cool to moderate weather or to prevent overhumidification. Modulation methods include tilting heat pipes, changing rotational speeds of (or stopping) heat wheels, or bypassing part of one airstream around the heat exchanger using dampers (i.e., changing the supply-to-exhaust mass airflow ratio).

Fouling

Fouling, an accumulation of dust or condensates on heat exchanger surfaces, reduces heat exchanger performance by increasing resistance to airflow, interfering with mass transfer, and generally decreasing heat transfer coefficients. Increased resistance to airflow increases fan power requirements and may reduce airflow.

Increased pressure drop across the heat exchanger core can indicate fouling and, with experience, may be used to establish cleaning

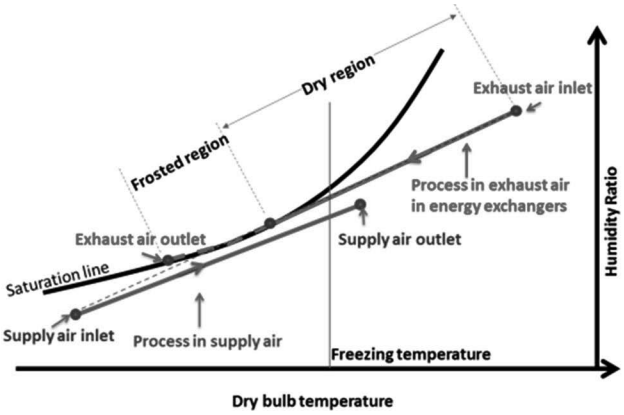

Fig. 27 Psychrometric Chart Showing the Processes in Exhaust and Supply Airstreams in Energy Exchangers

schedules. Reduced mass transfer performance (latent effectiveness) indicates fouling of permeable membranes or desiccant sorption sites. Heat exchanger surfaces must be kept clean to maximize system performance.

Corrosion

Process exhaust frequently contains corrosive substances. If it is not known which construction materials are most corrosion resistant for an application, the user and/or designer should examine on-site ductwork, review literature, and contact equipment suppliers before selecting materials. A corrosion study of heat exchanger construction materials in the proposed operating environment may be warranted if installation costs are high and the environment is corrosive. Experimental procedures for such studies are described in an ASHRAE symposium (ASHRAE 1982). Often contaminants not directly related to the process are present in the exhaust airstream (e.g., welding fumes or paint carryover from adjacent processes).

Moderate corrosion generally occurs over time, roughening metal surfaces and increasing their heat transfer coefficients. Severe corrosion reduces overall heat transfer and can cause cross-leakage between airstreams because of perforation or mechanical failure.

Condensation and Freeze-Up

Condensation, ice formation, and/or frosting may occur on heat exchange surfaces. Ignoring entrance and exit effects, four distinct air/moisture regimes may occur as the warm airstream cools from its inlet condition to its outlet condition. First, there is a dry region with no condensate. Once the warm airstream cools below its dew point, there is a condensing region, which wets the heat exchange surfaces. If the heat exchange surfaces fall below freezing, the condensation freezes. Finally, if the warm airstream temperature falls below its dew point and is also below freezing temperature, sublimation causes frost to form. The locations of these regions and rates of condensation and frosting depend on the duration of frosting conditions; airflow rates; inlet air temperature and humidity; heat exchanger core temperature; heat exchanger effectiveness; geometry, configuration, and orientation; and heat transfer coefficients. Figures 26 and 27 show the psychrometric process of the two airstreams when frosting happens for both energy exchanger and heat exchanger.

Sensible heat exchangers, which are ideally suited to applications in which heat transfer is desired but humidity transfer is not (e.g., swimming pools, kitchens, drying ovens), can benefit from the latent heat released by the exhaust gas when condensation occurs. One kilogram of moisture condensed transfers about 2440 kJ to the incoming air at room temperature. Equipment design should provide for continuous draining of the condensate from the unit. Transfer of latent heat occurs at the point of condensation, and little available energy remains in the condensate.

Condensation increases the heat transfer rate and thus the sensible effectiveness; it can also significantly increase pressure drops in heat exchangers with narrow airflow passage spacing. Frosting fouls the heat exchanger surfaces, which initially improves energy transfer but subsequently restricts the exhaust airflow, which in turn reduces the energy transfer rate. In extreme cases, the exhaust airflow (and supply, in the case of heat wheels) can become blocked. Defrosting a fully blocked heat exchanger requires that the unit be shut down for an extended period. As water cools and forms ice, it expands, which may seriously damage the heat exchanger core unless the water is entirely removed.

For frosting or icing to occur, an airstream must be cooled to a dew point below 0°C. Enthalpy exchangers transfer moisture from the airstream with higher moisture content (usually the warmer airstream) to the less humid one. As a result, frosting or icing occurs at lower supply air temperatures in enthalpy exchangers than in sensible heat exchangers. Cross-flow heat exchangers are more frost tolerant than other plate exchangers because frost blockage only occurs over a fraction of the exchanger exhaust airflow passages.

For these reasons, some form of freeze control must be incorporated into heat exchangers that are expected to operate under freezing conditions. Frosting and icing can be prevented by preheating supply air or reducing heat exchanger effectiveness (e.g., reducing heat wheel speed, tilting heat pipes, bypassing some supply air around the heat exchanger). Alternatively, the heat exchanger may be periodically defrosted. If cyclic defrost methods are used, the defrost period should be long enough to completely remove the frost, ice, and water during each defrost period. Care should also be taken to ensure that minimum ventilation requirements are still satisfied when cyclic defrost is used. Manufacturers of commercially available packaged heat or energy ventilators routinely incorporate frosting control strategies or mechanisms appropriate to their equipment and its targeted application.

ASHRAE research project RP-543 discusses performance of several freeze control strategies (Phillips et al. 1989a, 1989b). ASHRAE research project RP-544 (Barringer and McGugan 1989a, 1989b) covers performance of enthalpy heat exchangers. Many effective defrost strategies have been developed for residential air-to-air heat exchangers, and may also be applied to commercial installations. Phillips et al. (1992) describe frost control strategies and their impact on energy performance in various climates. Rafatinasr (2016) investigated the frosting threshold of fixed-plate cross-flow energy exchanger and its comparison with sensible heat exchangers, and conducted an exhaustive literature review on past research and typical defrosting methodologies and their impact on the performance of the exchangers.

See the Bibliography for sources of more information on frost growth and control.

Frost Control Strategies for Air-to-Air Energy Recovery Systems

In all cases, the potential for frost is in the warm-return-air side of the heat exchanger, which cools during a winter condition. For energy recovery devices, the exact outdoor air temperatures at which frosting will start depends on the temperature and humidity of the exhaust air and the type and performance of the energy recovery device. This temperature is known as the frost threshold temperature. The frost threshold varies by specific technology, and

significantly by whether water vapor is transferred between airstreams:

- **Flat Plate Heat Exchangers.** In flat plate heat exchangers (Figures 2 and 4), warm return air cools as it passes through the heat exchanger. Moisture from the warm air condenses and creates water droplets on the media; as cool outdoor air enters the heat exchanger, the water droplets start to freeze, creating ice on the cold corner of the core. Figure 1 shows a typical temperature distribution of warm and humid; and cold and dry air streams. The circled area shows the potential problem area for frost formation. In general, frost buildup becomes a problem when outdoor air temperatures reach about –5°C for sensible devices, or approximately –20°C for total energy devices. Figure 3 shows frost threshold for energy (Afshin 2019) and heat recovery ventilators.
- **Energy Recovery Wheels.** In energy recovery wheels (Figure 6), warm return air cools as it passes through the rotating wheel. Moisture from the warm air condenses and creates water droplets on the surface of the wheel. The water molecules are then absorbed by the desiccant on the enthalpy wheel or adsorbed into the airstream, in the case of sensible wheels. As the wheel rotates through the cold supply air, the water can start to freeze and form ice before the water droplets can be cleared from the wheel surface. Ice typically forms on the internal surface of the wheel, near the outdoor air intake which can cause damage and reduce airflow and performance.
- **Heat Pipe, Thermosiphon Loop, and Runaround Glycol Heat Exchangers.** In these technologies, the return air is cooled by a fluid passing through a coil. (Figures 10 and 15) For frost to form, the coil fin surface must be freezing and below the return air dew point. For frost to build up, the return air must be cooled below freezing. Using the sensible effectiveness, the user can calculate the outdoor air temperature where frost would be expected. For example, with a sensible effectiveness of 50%, an outdoor air temperature of –21°C would cool 21°C return air to 0°C.

There are a variety of different approaches that can be used to determine the frost threshold temperature, including measuring temperature, humidity, or a variation in pressure drop. A frost control strategy is then determined to either eliminate the frost once it builds up on the exchanger (before it becomes too severe), or to prevent frost formation from ever starting at all. The choice between frost control and frost prevention will depend on the robustness of the air-to-air energy recovery device and the application.

An effective frost control strategy is one that meets the requirements of the application while being cost-effective and device appropriate. Figure 28 shows the possible control strategies (Afshin 2019) for controlling frost for plate heat exchangers used as ERVs. Figure 29 shows examples of frost threshold temperatures for energy and heat recovery exchangers (Afshin 2019; Rafatinasr 2016).

In all cases of frost prevention, the amount of energy recovery is reduced and there will need to be additional heat added into the system. Energy efficiencies for each solution vary somewhat, and the

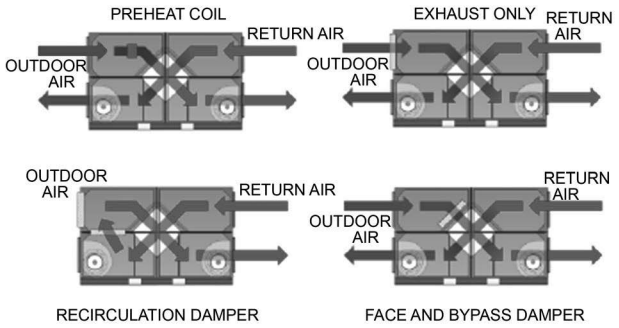

Fig. 28 Common Frost Control Strategies for Fixed-Plate Exchangers

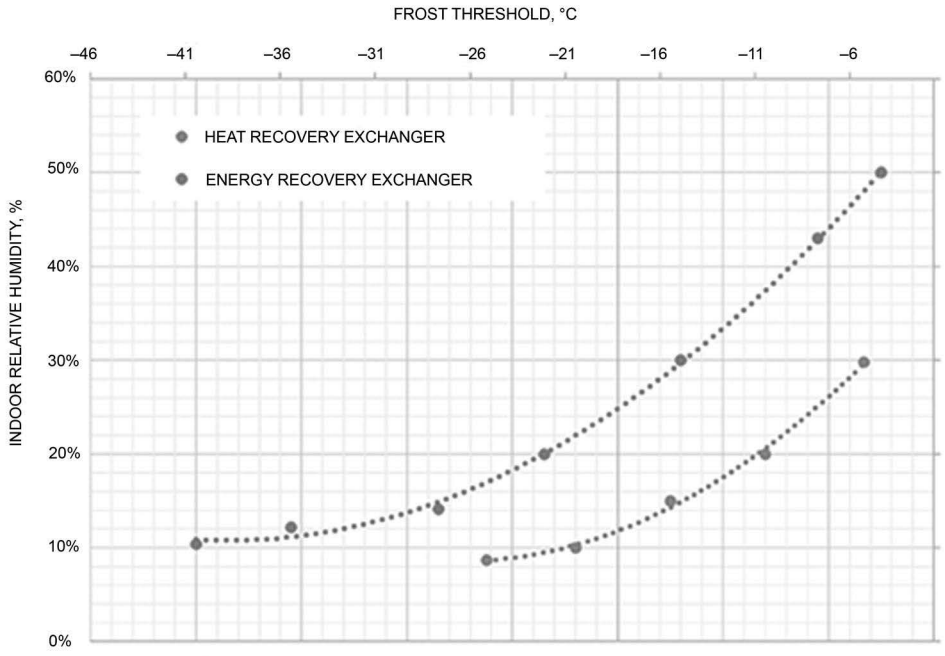

Fig. 29 Examples of Frost Threshold Temperatures for Energy and Heat Recovery Exchangers

(Afshin 2019)

best choice depends on application and the amount of upfront cost that can be tolerated.

Frost Prevention.

- *Preheat coil to heat up exhaust air*. Preheat frost control is a preventative strategy that can be used with any air-to-air energy recovery device. The objective is to prevent frost from occurring within the heat exchanger, while maintaining 100% or continuous ventilation. Energy recovery is reduced, because the difference in temperature between the preheated outside air and the return air has reduced. Heating coils (electric, steam, or hot water) are duct-mounted or integrated into the unit in the outdoor airstream so that the entering outdoor air temperature is preconditioned to a temperature above the frost threshold for the technology being used. While preheat typically has higher upfront costs than other strategies, it can result in significant operating savings in climates where frost control is required for a long period of time (more than a few hours). The preheater should be sized for the coldest outdoor air design temperature and to the appropriate outdoor air temperature where the exhaust air frost threshold is reached based on the design conditions and airflows for the type of heat exchanger selected. Figure 3 shows frost threshold characteristics for energy and heat recovery ventilators.
- *Face and bypass damper* (Figure 28). Face and bypass frost control is a preventative strategy that can be used for flat plates, heat pipes, and rotary wheel exchangers, with the objective of preventing frost formation while maintaining 100% ventilation. As the outdoor air becomes colder, face and bypass dampers upstream of the heat exchanger modulate to reduce the amount of outdoor air flowing through the heat exchanger. This reduces the amount of energy recovered and keeps the exhaust temperature above the frost threshold. The supply and exhaust fans, as well as the outdoor air and exhaust air dampers, continue to operate during the frost control cycle. With this strategy there is no interrupted ventilation which makes it ideal for harsher environments or source control applications like laboratories. Furthermore, as both fans run continuously there is no depressurization of the building, eliminating the potential for combustion appliance backdraft into the occupied space. The lower leaving supply air temperature would potentially require post-conditioning, or some type of terminal reheat within the space to ensure that occupants remain comfortable under extreme conditions. A further advantage would be that the face-and-bypass can also be used for free cooling (economizer) and/or supply air temperature control in different modes of operation if required.
- *Performance modulation*. The heat exchanger can be controlled to ensure that frost does not form in the return air, by reducing the effectiveness and, as a result, suppressing the frost threshold. For example, wheel rotational speed can be reduced, runaround pumps can be slowed, heat pipes can be equipped with control valves or tilted. Since the heat exchanger is recovering less energy, more heating is required in the process downstream.

Defrosting.

1. *Exhaust defrosting* (Figure 28). Exhaust-only defrost is one of the most cost-effective and simple strategies to implement. It periodically defrosts ice forming on the heat exchanger by shutting down the supply fan to remove the source of cold air, while using the warm exhaust air to heat up the exchanger. When the unit goes into a defrost cycle, the exhaust fan continues to operate, the supply fan is deenergized and the outdoor air damper closes. This method is most commonly used with flat plate or heat pipe heat exchangers and is ideal for source control applications where continuous exhaust is required. One drawback of this method is that ventilation is interrupted when the supply fan shuts down during the defrost cycle, which may not be acceptable as the equipment may not meet indoor air quality (IAQ) requirements as defined by ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1. This also creates negative indoor pressure, resulting in infiltration.
2. *Recirculation defrost* (Figure 28). Recirculation defrost is also cost-effective and simple, commonly used in light commercial stand-alone air-to-air ERVs that are not used as a primary ventilation system. Ice formation on the heat exchanger is periodically defrosted by shutting down the exhaust fan, by closing the outdoor and exhaust air dampers, and by opening a recirculation air damper to remove the source of cold air. When the unit goes into a defrost cycle, the supply fan remains on to recirculate building exhaust air back into the occupied space. The exhaust air goes through the heat exchanger and provides defrosting in the absence of cold outdoor air. A drawback of this method is that ventilation is interrupted when the exhaust fan shuts down during the defrost cycle. This may not be acceptable in all applications and may not meet indoor air quality (IAQ) requirements as set out in ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1. It may however be acceptable in more moderate climates where freezing conditions occur only during unoccupied hours for a few hours per year.

Direct and Indirect Evaporative Air Cooling

In indirect evaporative air cooling, exhaust air passing through a water spray absorbs water vapor until it becomes nearly saturated. As the water evaporates, it absorbs sensible energy from the air, lowering its temperature. The evaporatively cooled exhaust air can then be used to cool supply air through an air-to-air heat exchanger, which may be used either for year-round energy recovery or exclusively for its evaporative cooling benefits. This process follows a constant wet-bulb line on a psychrometric chart: the airstream enthalpy remains nearly constant, moisture content increases, and dry-bulb temperature decreases.

Indirect evaporative cooling has been used with heat pipe heat exchangers, runaround coil loop exchangers, and flat-plate heat exchangers for summer cooling (Dhital et al. 1995; Johnson et al. 1995; Mathur 1990a, 1990b, 1992, 1993; Scofield and Taylor 1986). Exhaust air or a scavenging airstream is cooled by passing it through a water spray, wet filter, or other wetted media, resulting in a greater overall temperature difference between the supply and exhaust or scavenging airstreams and thus more heat transfer. Energy recovery is further enhanced by improved heat transfer coefficients because of wetted exhaust-side heat transfer surfaces. No moisture is added to the supply airstream, and there are no auxiliary energy inputs other than fan and water pumping power. The coefficient of performance (COP) tends to be high, typically from 9 to 20, depending on available dry-bulb temperature depression. The dry-bulb temperature decrease in the exhaust airstream caused by evaporative cooling tends to be 85 to 95% of the maximum available difference between the exhaust air inlet dry-bulb and wet-bulb temperatures. Therefore, exhaust air evaporative cooling is usually most cost effective in hot, dry climates where the evaporator can be used frequently to obtain large exhaust air dry-bulb temperature depressions.

Without a bypass scheme for either the evaporator or air-to-air heat exchanger, the net annual energy costs include the extra annual fan power for these devices as well as the benefit of evaporative cooling.

Because less mechanical cooling is required with evaporative cooling, energy consumption and peak demand load are both reduced, yielding lower energy bills. Overall mechanical refrigeration system requirements are reduced, allowing use of smaller mechanical refrigeration systems. In some cases, the mechanical system may be eliminated. Chapter 41 of this volume and Chapter 53 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* have further information on evaporative cooling.

Example 3. Indirect Evaporative Cooling Recovery. Room air at 30°C and 17°C wb (ρ = 1.2 kg/m^3) with a flow rate of 15 m^3/s is used to pre-

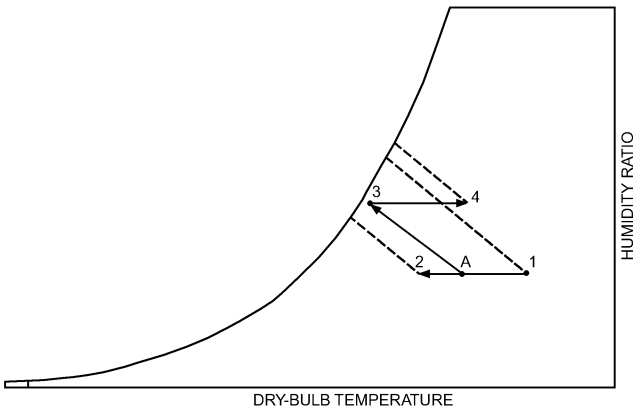

Fig. 30 Indirect Evaporative Cooling Recovery (Example 3)

cool 15 m^3/s of supply outdoor air at 39°C and 20°Cwb (ρ = 1.13 kg/m^3) using an aluminum fixed-plate heat exchanger and indirect evaporative cooling. The evaporative cooler increases the exhaust air to 90% rh before it enters the heat exchanger. The sensible effectiveness is given by the manufacturer as 78%. Assuming EATR = 0 and OACF ≈ 1, determine the leaving supply air conditions and energy recovered, and check the energy exchange balance.

Solution:

First, determine the exhaust air condition entering the exchanger (i.e., after it is adiabatically cooled). Air at 30°C db, 17°C wb cools to 18°C db, 17°C wb as shown by the process line from point A to point 3 in Figure 30. In this problem the volumetric flows are equal, but the mass flows are not.

1. Because data on pressure drop are missing, skip this step.

2. Calculate the theoretical maximum heat transfer.

Based on a preliminary assessment, the supply air is not expected to cool below its wet-bulb temperature of 20°C. Thus, use the denominator of sensible heat effectiveness Equation (2a) and, for simplification, assume the specific heat of 1.0 kJ/(kg·K).

$$q_{max}\ (\text{sensible}) = (1.13\ \text{kg/m}^3)(15\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1.0\ \text{kJ/(kg}\cdot\text{K)}](39 - 18) = 356\ \text{kW}$$

3. Establish the sensible effectiveness.

From manufacturer's exchanger selection data for indirect evaporative coolers, an effectiveness of 78% is found to be appropriate.

4. Calculate actual energy transfer at the design conditions.

$$q_{actual} = (0.78)(356\ \text{kW}) = 278\ \text{kW recovered}$$

5. Calculate leaving air conditions.

a. Leaving supply air temperature is

$$t_2 = 39°\text{C} + \frac{-278\ \text{kW}}{(1.13\ \text{kg/m}^3)(15\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg}\cdot\text{K)}]} = 22.6°\text{C}$$

b. Leaving exhaust air temperature is

$$t_4 = 18°\text{C} + \frac{278\ \text{kW}}{(1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)(15\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg}\cdot°\text{C)}]} = 33.4°\text{C}$$

6. Check performance.

$q_s = (1.13\ \text{kg/m}^3)(15\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg}\cdot\text{K)}](39 - 22.6\text{K}) = 278\ \text{kW}$ recovered

$q_e = (1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)(15\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg}\cdot\text{K)}](33.4 - 18\text{K})$
$= 278\ \text{kW}$ recovered

7. Plot conditions on psychrometric chart (Figure 30), and confirm that no latent exchange occurred.

Because EATR = 0 and OACF is 1, Steps 8 to 10 are not presented here.

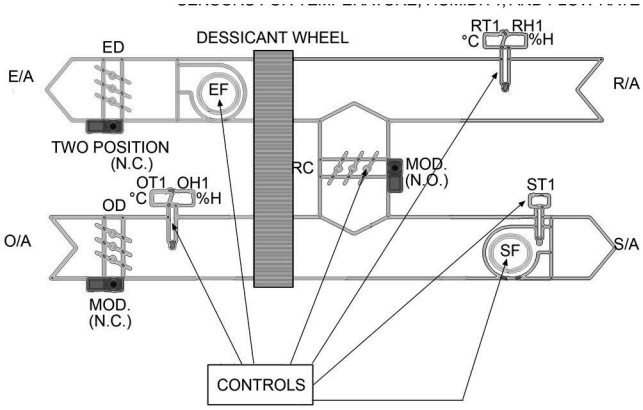

Fig. 31 Economizer with Dessicant Wheel

(Pieper 2015)

Use of Economizer

ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 specifies the use of economizer whenever the conditions of the outdoor air, especially enthalpy, are lower than that of the return air. Typically, the use of economizer depends on factors such as the characteristics of the building envelope, number of occupants, internal loads, and the location of the building. An economizer may be required for buildings in U.S. climate zones other than 1a,1b, 2a, and 2b, provided the cooling capacity is higher than 11 tons in the moist region and 5 tons for the dry regions. Exceptions might exist for other regions for just a few hours of the year, which may not justify the use of economizer for economic considerations. A schematic of the economizer along with energy recovery wheel as shown in Figure 31.

If the outdoor temperature appears better than that of the return air (Pieper 2015), there would be a call for the economizer to engage, but if the enthalpy of the outdoor air could be worse than that of the return air, the economizer should not be in operation. Enthalpy comparison prevents excess moisture being brought into the space. It is also important to note that not all outdoor air passes through the energy recovery device, in order to prevent excessive fan power associated with recovery device and bypass dampers. Dampers shown in Figure 28 have a wide range of flow rates such that the system may provide 100% outdoor air or less flow rate in combination with the return air through return air damper. The controls may be programmed to supply the required supply air conditions such that the mass flow rate and the enthalpy of the supply air satisfy the following equation.

$$m_s(h_r - h_s) = q_t \tag{22}$$

where

m_s = mass flow rate of the supply air, kg/s
h_r = enthalpy of the room air, kJ/kg_{DA}
h_s = enthalpy of the supply air, kJ/kg_{DA}
q_t = total building load at the time, kW

Building loads vary each hour, as does the sensible heat ratio (SHR), however, for the peak load conditions, the supply air conditions are determined based on the supply air temperature (T_s) as shown in Figure 32. The letters X and Y in Figure 32 indicate the states of supply and room air, respectively, and that the SHR line AO on the protractor is parallel to the line XY.

In Figure 32, it is assumed that SHR = 0.7, however it changes by the hour. The challenge lies in the ability of the control system (shown in Figure 31) to modulate the flow rates of the outdoor air and the return air.

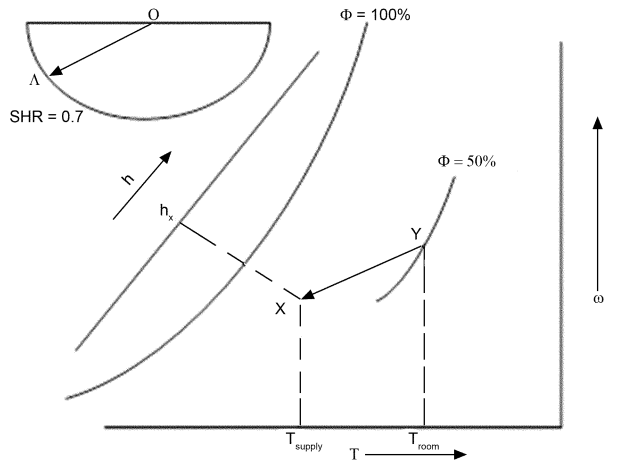

Fig. 32 Supply Conditions for Given Load q_t and Given SHR

6. COMPARISON OF AIR-TO-AIR HEAT OR HEAT AND MASS EXCHANGER CHARACTERISTICS

It is difficult to compare different types of air-to-air energy recovery systems based on overall performance. They can be compared based on certified ratings such as sensible, latent, and total effectiveness or on air leakage parameters. Comparing them on payback period or maximum energy cost savings requires accurate values of their capital cost, life, and maintenance cost, which vary from product to product for the same type of recovery system. Without such data, and considering the data available in the open literature such as that presented by Besant and Simonson (2003), use Table 3's comparative data for common types of air-to-air energy recovery devices.

7. USE OF AIR-TO-AIR HEAT OR HEAT AND MASS EXCHANGERS IN SYSTEMS

Characterizing System Efficiency of Heat or Energy Recovery Ventilators

A measure of energy recovery ventilator performance is the relative magnitude of actual energy recovered and power supplied to fans to circulate the airstreams. The cost of power supplied to the fans depends on the pressure drop of airstreams, volume flow rate, and combined efficiency of the fan motor systems. The quality of power supplied to the fans is high, and its cost per unit energy is much higher than the quality and cost of energy recovered in the ventilator. The magnitude and costs of these two forms of energy vary over the year. Besant and Simonson (2003) suggest that a parameter such as **recovery efficiency ratio (RER)** may be introduced to characterize the efficiency of the recovery ventilators:

$$\text{RER} = \frac{\int(\text{rate of energy recovered})\,dt}{\int(\text{rate of power supplied to fan motors})\,dt} \quad (23)$$

RER is similar to the energy efficiency ratio (EER) for chillers or unitary air-conditioning equipment. Besant and Simonson (2003) also suggest that the entire system performance, including the recovery ventilator, can be represented by the ratio of COP and RER.

RER is typically expressed in units of kJ/Wh; energy recovered can be sensible, latent, or total, in kilowatts, and energy expended is that spent for circulating exhaust and supply air through the energy recovery unit, expressed in watts. In AHRI *Guideline* V, RER_{Total}, $\text{RER}_{sensible}$, and RER_{latent} are defined as

$$\text{RER}_{Total} = \frac{\varepsilon_{net\ total}\,\dot{m}_{min}(h_1 - h_3)}{P_{blower} + P_{comp}} \quad (24a)$$

$$\text{RER}_{sensible} = \frac{\varepsilon_{net\ sensible}\,\dot{m}_{min}c_p(t_1 - t_3)}{P_{blower} + P_{comp}} \quad (24b)$$

$$\text{RER}_{latent} = \frac{\varepsilon_{net\ latent}\,\dot{m}_{min}h_{fg}(\omega_1 - \omega_3)}{P_{blower} + P_{comp}} \quad (24c)$$

where

$\dot{m}_{min}$ = minimum mass flow rate of supply and exhaust airstreams
h_1 = enthalpy at state 1
t_1 = temperature at state 1
ω_1 = humidity ratio at state 1
P_{comp} = direct power input of recovery component
P_{blower} = blower power required for energy recovery component

$$P_{blower} = \left[\frac{Q_{blower\ supply}\Delta P_{supply}}{\eta_{fan/motor\ supply}}\right] + \left[\frac{Q_{blower\ exhaust}\Delta P_{exhaust}}{\eta_{fan/motor\ exhaust}}\right] \quad (25)$$

where

ΔP = pressure loss of component for supply or exhaust airstreams, kPa
$Q_{blower\ supply}$ = supply fan airflow, L/s
$Q_{blower\ exhaust}$ = exhaust fan airflow, L/s
$\eta_{fan/motor}$ = combined fan and motor efficiency

Note that other alternatives (e.g., comparing operating points on a fan curve) that accurately characterize the additional fan power required by the component are acceptable means of obtaining blower power.

For a flow rate of 470 L/s and typical values of airstream pressure drop and motor and fan efficiencies, $\text{RER}_{sensible}$ can range from 26 to 32 kJ/Wh. The calculated value of RER suggest that the energy recovered is about 7.3 to 8.8 times that used to operate the energy recovery unit. The quality of thermal energy is about one-third that of electric power, so the actual energy recovered is about three times the cost of energy spent for energy recovery.

The **combined efficiency (CEF)** is the ratio of the net heating/cooling delivered to the total electric power consumed. CEF can also be related to the sensible, latent, or total recovered energy and is related to the RER; energy efficiency ratio (EER), which is typically provided by manufacturers of unitary equipment; and load ratio *Y*. It represents the percentage of the system load (heating, cooling, humidification and/or dehumidification) met by the energy recovery component. The higher load ratio allows use of smaller equipment, thereby affecting capital costs. $\text{CEF}_{cooling}$ can be estimated as

$$\text{CEF}_{cooling} = \frac{1}{Y_c/\text{RER} + (1 - Y_c)/\text{EER}} \quad (26)$$

where

$$Y_c = \frac{\text{Net cooling capacity of energy recovery unit}}{\text{System net cooling capacity}} \quad (27)$$

$$\text{EER} = \frac{\text{Net cooling capacity}}{\text{Total electric consumption}} \quad (28)$$

For a typical value of EER = 10 for a unitary system, and a load ratio of about 0.3, the $\text{CEF}_{cooling}$ can range from 15 to 19 kJ/Wh. Use of an energy recovery unit and its effects on system sizing and annual net savings for various climatic regions are discussed in AHRI *Guideline* V.

Table 3 Comparison of Air-to-Air Energy Recovery Devices

	Fixed Plate	Membrane Plate	Energy Wheel	Heat Wheel	Heat Pipe	Runaround Coil Loop	Thermosiphon	Liquid Desiccant	Fixed-Bed Regenerator
Airflow arrangements	Counterflow Cross flow[a]	Counterflow Cross flow[a]	Counterflow Parallel flow	Counterflow	Counterflow Parallel flow	—	Counterflow Parallel flow	—	Counterflow
Equipment size range, L/s	25 and up	25 and up	25 to 35 000 and up	25 to 35 000 and up	50 and up	50 and up	50 and up	—	25 and up
Typical sensible effectiveness ($m_s = m_e$), %[c]	50 to 75	55 to 75	65 to 80	65 to 80	40 to 60[b]	45 to 65[b]	40 to 60	40 to 60[b]	80 to 90[c]
Typical latent effectiveness,* %[c]	0	25 to 60	50 to 80	0	0	0	0	50 to 75[b,d]	60 to 80 with dessicant coating[c]
Total effectiveness,* %[c]	20 to 50	35 to 70	55 to 80	25 to 60	15 to 35	—	—	40 to 75[d]	50 to 80[c]
Face velocity, m/s	1 to 5	1 to 3	2.5 to 5	2 to 5	2 to 4	1.5 to 3	2 to 4	1.5 to 2.2	1 to 2.5
Pressure drop, Pa	100 to 1000	100 to 500	100 to 300	100 to 300	150 to 500	150 to 500	150 to 500	170 to 300	50 to 300
EATR, %	0 to 2	0 to 5	0.5 to 10	0.5 to 10	0 to 1	0	0	0	3 to 5[c]
OACF	0.97 to 1.06	0.97 to 1.06	0.99 to 1.1	0.95 to 1.5	0.99 to 1.01	1.0	1.0	1.0	0.90 to 1[c]
Temperature range, °C	–60 to 800	–40 to 60	–55 to 800	–55 to 800	–40 to 93	–45 to 500	–40 to 40	–40 to 46	–55 to 60
Typical mode of purchase	Exchanger only Exchanger in case Exchanger and blowers Complete system	Exchanger only Exchanger in case Exchanger and blowers Complete system	Exchanger only Exchanger in case Exchanger and blowers Complete system	Exchanger only Exchanger in case Exchanger and blowers Complete system	Exchanger only Exchanger in case Exchanger and blowers Complete system	Coil only Complete system	Exchanger only Exchanger in case	Complete system	Exchanger and damper Complete system
Advantages	No moving parts Low pressure drop Easily cleaned	No moving parts Low pressure drop Low air leakage Moisture/mass transfer	Moisture/mass transfer Compact large sizes Low pressure drop Available on all ventilation system platforms	Compact large sizes Low pressure drop Easily cleaned	No moving parts except tilt Fan location not critical Allowable pressure differential up to 15 kPa	Exhaust airstream can be separated from supply air Fan location not critical	No moving parts Exhaust airstream can be separated from supply air Fan location not critical	Latent transfer from remote airstreams Efficient microbiological cleaning of both supply and exhaust airstreams	Few moving parts Defrost strategy not required Low maintenance Easily cleaned Moisture/mass transfer if dessicant-coated
Limitations	Large size at higher flow rates	Few suppliers Long-term maintenance and performance unknown	Supply air may require some further cooling or heating Some EATR without purge	Some EATR	Effectiveness limited by pressure drop and cost Few suppliers	Predicting performance requires accurate simulation model	Effectiveness may be limited by pressure drop and cost Few suppliers	Few suppliers Maintenance and performance unknown	Indoor units may require additional airflow selector/damper to control EATR Some EATR
Heat rate control (HRC) methods	Bypass dampers and ducting	Bypass dampers and ducting	Bypass dampers and wheel speed control	Bypass dampers and wheel speed control	Tilt angle down to 10% of maximum heat rate	Bypass valve or pump speed control	Control valve over full range	Control valve or pump speed control over full range	Bypass damper and ducting Recovery period timing

[a]Rated effectiveness values are for balanced flow conditions for cross flow. Effectiveness values increase slightly if flow rates of either or both airstreams are higher than flow rates at which testing is done.

[b]Data not based on third-party certified data.

[c]Data based on typical range of third-party certified data.

[d]Face velocity of 1.27 to 2.54 m/s.

EATR = exhaust air transfer ratio

OACF = outdoor air correction factor

Selection of Heat or Energy Recovery Ventilators

Heat and energy recovery ventilators are available as heat exchangers only or as a complete system, including the heat exchangers and fan/motor systems, as indicated in Table 3. Energy recovery is also available integrated into unitary air-conditioning equipment or in both standard and custom air-handling systems. Selection of such units is primarily dictated by the quantity of ventilation air. Several manufacturers have developed software or tables to help select these units. The user may have to determine the required fan size (see Example 8), if only the heat exchanger is to be purchased.

However, the true overall system performance is the life-cycle cost, which takes into account the capital and maintenance costs. Because of lack of sufficient data on these factors, they are not presented in Table 3.

Systems with Multiple Energy Recovery Exchangers

Multiple exchangers are often used in air-handling systems that have a cooling coil, to enhance dehumidification capability. The first air-to-air exchanger in the outdoor airstream is used to recover exhaust energy and reduce the required coil capacity. The second exchanger's purpose is to increase the coil's latent removal. This second exchanger is either a sensible heat exchanger or a passive desiccant wheel. A sensible exchanger (e.g., coil loop, plate exchanger, heat pipe, wheel) reheats the air as it leaves the cooling coil. This simultaneously precools the return air. The cooled return air that is exhausted then precools the outdoor air by passing through the first exchanger. A passive dehumidification wheel works similarly: it removes water vapor from air leaving the coil and transfers the vapor, with some heat, to the return air. The second exchanger can be in parallel with the first exchanger, as shown in Figure 33 (Moffitt 2011). The corresponding processes are shown in Figure 34 (Moffitt 2011); use of a passive desiccant wheel is shown on the right side of the figure.

The second exchanger can also be placed in series with the cooling coil, as shown in Figure 35 (Moffitt 2011), where it has a similar effect. The first exchanger reduces the cooling capacity by recovery exhaust energy. The second exchanger improves latent cooling and reduces the sensible cooling delivered by the system. The corresponding processes are shown in Figure 36 (Moffitt 2011); use of a passive desiccant wheel is shown on the right side of the figure.

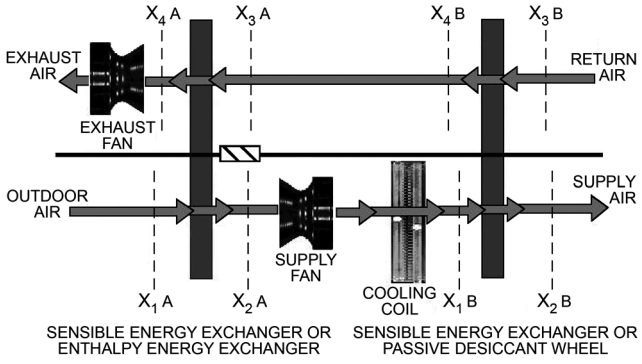

Fig. 33 Multiple Energy Recovery Exchangers in Parallel Mode

Using Air-to-Air Heat Exchangers to Modify the Latent Capacity Ratio of Cooling Coils

Air-to-air energy recovery can be used in a series application where heat is transferred from one location in an airstream (where the heat is detrimental) to another location in the same airstream (where the heat is beneficial). The most common example of this application is in series energy recovery around a cooling coil for summer dehumidification. During dehumidification the warm, humid outside air is cooled by a cooling coil so the dry bulb temperature reaches the desired dew point. This air is then reheated to reduce its relative humidity (for indoor air quality, IAQ), and to make it more comfortable before entering the building space. The in-series energy recovery device is placed in front of and after the cooling coil, where it provides precooling (reducing load on the cooling coil) and reheat (reducing load on the reheating equipment). Figure 37 provides an example and shows the driving force (left) and the enthalpy savings (right). In some cases, the outdoor air reaches saturation during precool, and humidity is removed before the air enters the cooling coil. The total energy consumption (kWh) and peak demand (kW) load are both reduced, yielding lower energy bills and healthier IAQ (Mathur 1997a, 1997b, 1997c, 1997d).

Since there must be energy balance between the precool side and reheat side, the changes in enthalpy will always be equal and opposite. Where there is no condensation during precool, the ΔT across the precool side will be equal and opposite to the reheat side. When condensation occurs during precool, the ΔT across the precool side will be smaller than the reheat side.

Even on direct-expansion (DX) systems where hot gas reheat is a resource created by the process, in-series energy recovery can be used to reduce compressor capacity and downsize equipment to reduce first costs, particularly where condensation takes place on more of the DX coil, which increases the cycle's coefficient of performance (COP).

Because both precooling and reheating are beneficial to the system, the RER in dehumidification applications is double that of an identical exchanger used in energy recovery. Also, the driving force is the dry-bulb temperature difference between the outdoor air and the cooling coil leaving temperature. For example, on a 32°C day and with 13°C air leaving the cooling coil, the driving force across the energy recovery device is 7°C. In contrast, a traditional air-to-air energy recovery device with outdoor air at 32°C and return air at 24°C is exposed to a driving temperature difference of only 8 K, a third of the in-series energy recovery device.

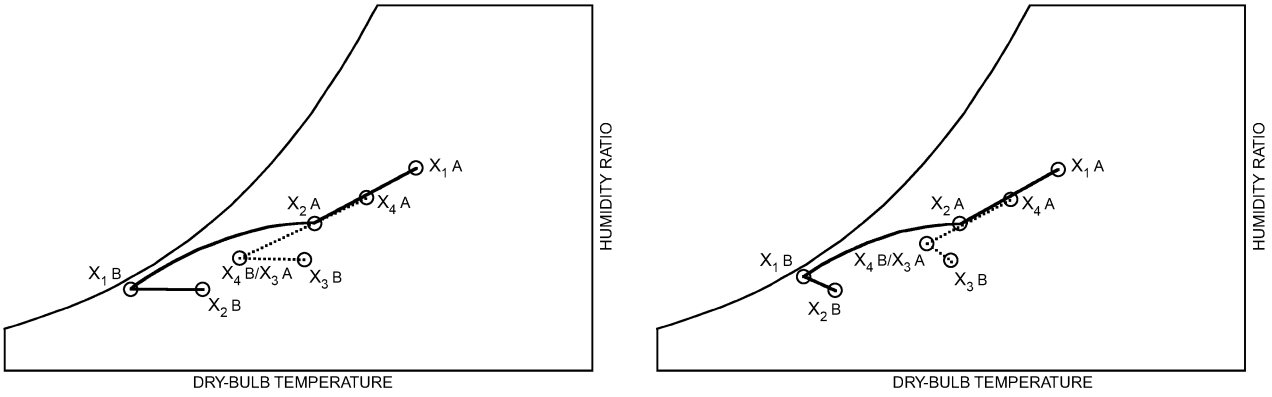

Fig. 34 Psychrometric Processes of Exchangers in Parallel Mode

(Moffitt 2011)

Furthermore, when the energy recovery device is in economizer mode (outdoor air temperatures of about 13 to 24°C) the in-series recovery device is still recovering energy.

The in-series energy recovery device should be sized for the highest dry-bulb temperature design condition, since this is when the device is exposed to the highest driving force and creates most reheat. This ensures the system will never provide too much reheat during the year. This approach is the simplest and is used when the primary goal is to downsize cooling equipment. The system designer must recognize that when the outdoor temperature is lower, that the driving force is also lower, and the device provides less reheat. If the design reheat is required during the whole cooling season, then supplemental reheat is still required after the in-series energy recovery device, albeit less than in a system without energy recovery.

An alternative design strategy is to optimize energy recovery. In this strategy, the system designer selects a device with a higher effectiveness than in the previous strategy, and provides a means of modulating its performance. By modulating the performance during the warmest outdoor air conditions, excessive reheat is avoided. During cooler conditions the device operates at full performance to recover more energy. The device is usually sized with a mind to pressure drop, recognizing that the airstream passes through the device twice, and initial purchase cost and is optimized against annual energy savings.

Examples of devices are wraparound heat pipes and thermosiphons (Figures 38 and 41), flat heat exchangers like wheels and heat pipes (Figure 39), and plate heat exchangers (Figure 40). Footprint and condensation management should be considered when designing the layout. Where a controllable device is required, options include: wraparound heat pipes and thermosiphons that use valves to control refrigerant flow; bypass around

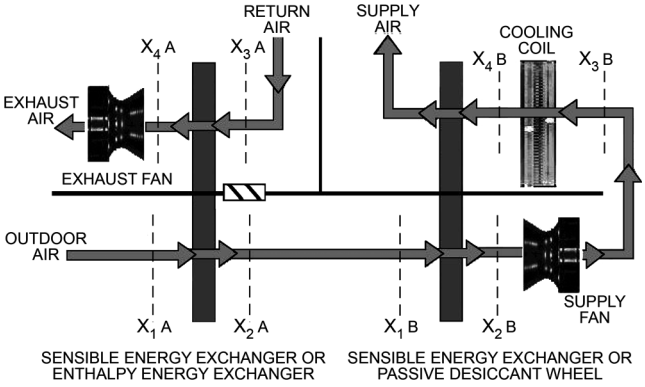

Fig. 35 Multiple Energy Recovery Exchangers in Parallel Mode

(Moffitt 2011)

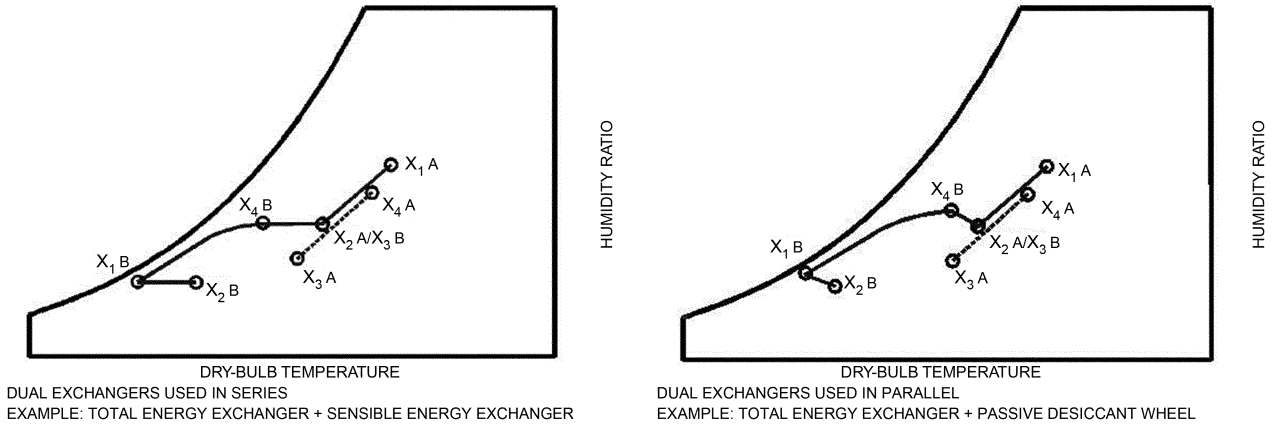

Fig. 36 Psychrometric Processes of Exchangers in Series Mode

(Moffitt 2011)

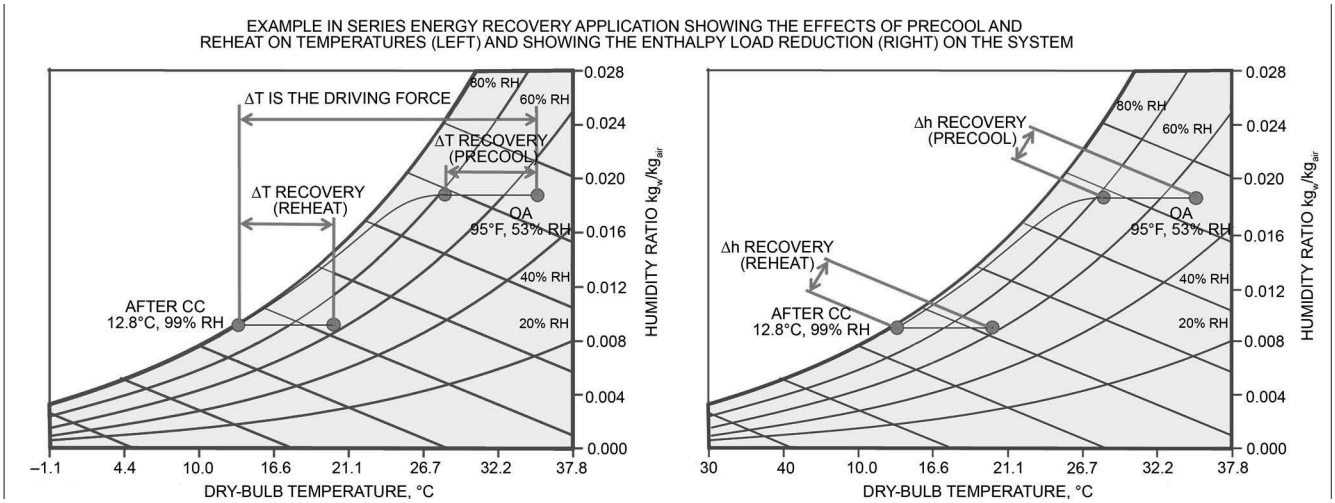

Fig. 37 Psychrometric Chart: In-Series Energy Recovery

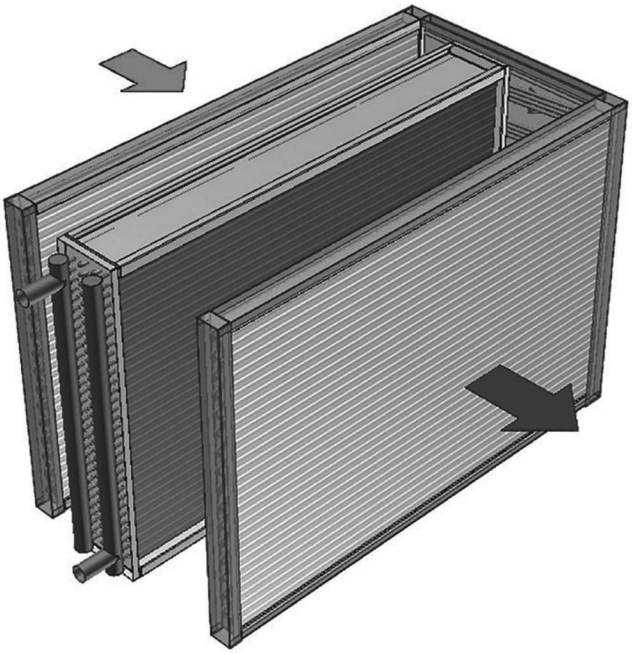

Fig. 38 Wraparound (In-Series) Heat Pipe

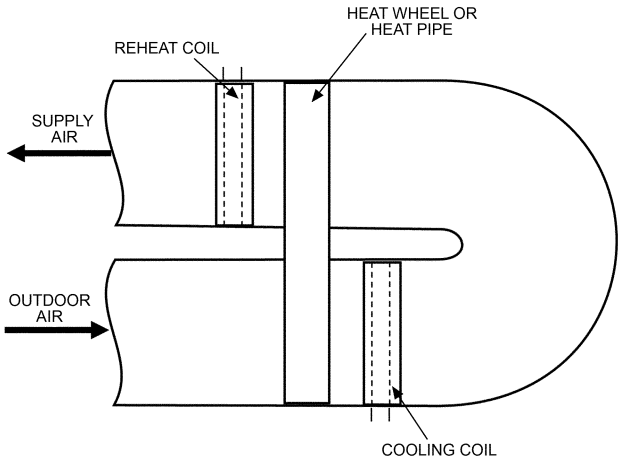

Fig. 39 Flat Heat Recovery Device in Wraparound (In-Series) Configuration

the device (but not through the cooling coil); or, for wheels, modulating wheel speed.

Example 4. Precooling Air Reheater Dehumidifier. In this application, 1.6m^3/s of outdoor supply air at 35 and 27°Cwb (ρ = 1.11 kg/m^3) is used to reheat 1.6 m^3/s of the same air leaving a cooling coil (exhaust) at 11.2 and 11.0°C wb using a sensible heat exchanger as a precooling air reheater. The reheated air is to be between 24 and 26°C. In this application, the warm airstream is outdoor air and the cold airstream is the same air after it leaves the cooling coil. The unit's manufacturer lists its effectiveness as 58.4%. For EATR = 0 and OACF ≈1, determine the leaving precooled and reheated air conditions and energy recovered, and check the energy exchange balance.

Solution:

Step 1. Because data on pressure drop are missing, skip this step.

Step 2. Calculate the theoretical maximum energy transfer.

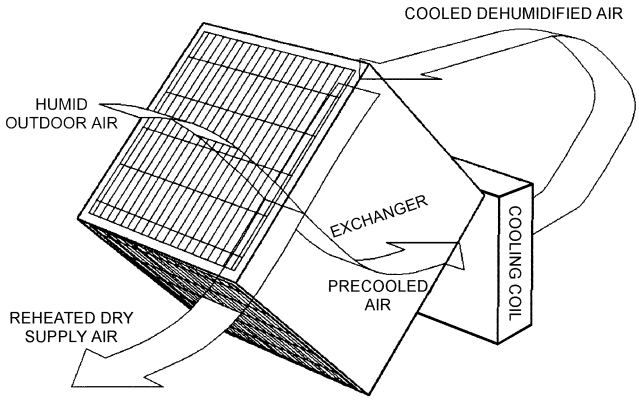

Fig. 40 Flat Plate Heat Exchanger in Wraparound (In-Series) Configuration

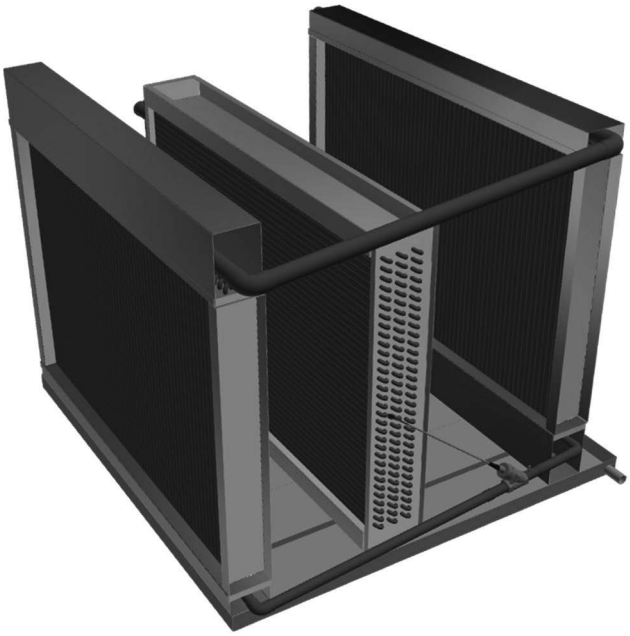

Fig. 41 Wraparound (In-Series) Thermosiphon with a Valve for Modulation

The air being reheated will have less mass than the outdoor air entering the precooler because moisture will condense from it as it passes through the precooler and cooling coil. Reheat is sensible heat only, so the denominator of Equation (2a) is used to determine the theoretical maximum energy transfer. To simplify the calculation, it is assumed that specific heat of dry air is constant at 1 kJ/(kg·K.

$$q_s = 1.11(1.6)(1)(35 - 11.2) = 42.3 \text{ kW saved}$$

Step 3. Establish the sensible effectiveness. The manufacturer gives the effectiveness as 58.4% at the designated operating conditions.

Step 4. Calculate actual energy transfer at design conditions.

$$q_{actual} = 0.584(42.3) = 24.7 \text{ kW}$$

Step 5. Calculate leaving air conditions. Because condensation occurs as the outdoor airstream passes through the precooling side of the heat exchanger, use Equation (4e) to determine its leaving enthalpy, which is the inlet condition for the cooling coil. Sensible heat transfer Equation (5a) is used to determine the temperature of air leaving the preheat side of the heat exchanger.

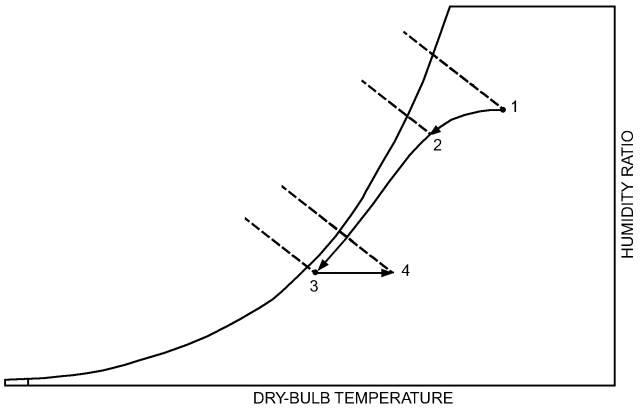

Fig. 42 Precooling Air Reheater Dehumidifier (Example 4)

a. Precooler leaving air conditions

Entering enthalpy, determined from the psychrometric chart for 35°C db and 27°C wb, is 85.2 kJ/kg.

$$h_2 = 85.2 + \frac{-24.7}{1.11(1.6)} = 71.3 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

The wet-bulb temperature for saturated air with this enthalpy is 23.5°C. This is point 2 on the psychrometric chart (Figure 42), which is near saturation. Note that this precooled air is further dehumidified by a cooling coil.

b. Reheater leaving air conditions

$$t_4 = 11.2 + \frac{24.7}{1.11(1.6)(1)} = 25.1°\text{C}$$

Entering enthalpy, determined from the psychrometric chart for 11.2°C db and 11.0°C wb, is 32.0 kJ/kg.

$$h_4 = 32 + \frac{24.7}{1.11(1.6)} = 45.9 \text{ kJ/kg}$$

The wet-bulb temperature for air with this temperature and enthalpy is 16.3°C.

Step 6. Check performance.

$$q_s = 1.11(1.6)(85.2 - 71.3) = 24.7 \text{ kW precooling}$$

$$q_e = 1.11(1.6)(1)(25.1 - 11.2) = 24.7 \text{ kW reheat}$$

Step 7. Plot conditions on psychrometric chart (Figure 42). Because EATR = 0 and OACF ≈ 1, Steps 8 to 10 are not presented here.

Dessicant and Heat Wheel Systems

The Center for Climate and Energy Solutions' 2015 international conference on climate change emphasized reducing greenhouse gas emissions and requiring more efficient equipment, including HVAC systems (which consume significant electrical power) (C2ES 2015). Sensible and desiccant wheels can be used in combination with a heat pump direct evaporative cooler (DEC) to achieve this goal, as shown in the following cases.

The heat dissipated in the condenser of a heat pump can be used to regenerate the desiccant wheel (Sheng et al. 2015) and has a potential of significant energy cost savings. At design conditions for Atlanta, Georgia, for a 100% replacement air system as shown in Figure 43, this approach can reduce cooling capacity requirements by 52% and net electrical shaft power requirements by more than 24% compared to the conventional vapor-compression system (Dhamshala 2016).

Figure 44 shows an advanced desiccant system for 100% outdoor supply air (OSA) mode with heat and desiccant wheels and

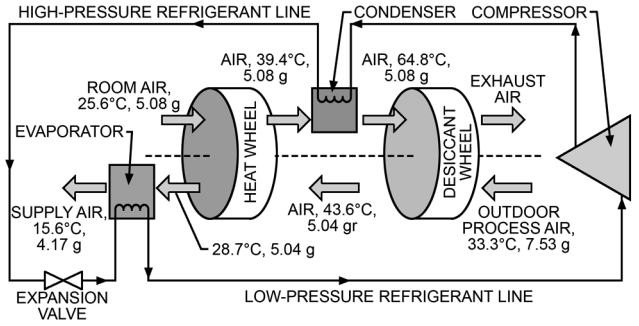

Fig. 43 Heat Pump Augmented by Heat and Dessicant Wheels

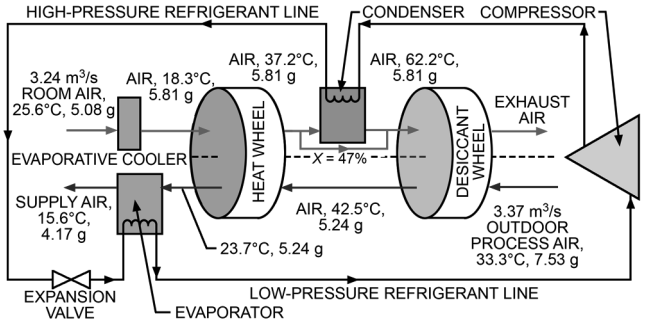

Fig. 44 Heat Pump Augmented by Evaporative Cooler and Heat and Dessicant Wheels

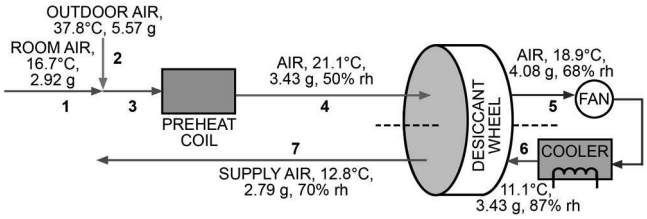

Fig. 45 System for Surgery Room

(based on concepts presented in Murphy 2006)

direct evaporative cooler (DEC) in combination with a heat pump. This system could reduce cooling capacity requirements by 59% and net electrical shaft power requirements by close to 30% at the same design conditions as for Figure 43 (Dhamshala 2016).

A simplified system suitable for surgery rooms (able to provide optimum temperature and humidity control) consists of a preheater, desiccant wheel with type 3 desiccant, and a cooling coil, as shown in Figure 45. The type 3 desiccant in the desiccant wheel has a large affinity to adsorb water vapor when the relative humidity of the air is high (as it is in states 6 and 7), whereas it gives off moisture at states 4 and 5 (which have lower humidity). The simplicity of this system not only reduces maintenance costs but can also save significant energy costs.

A desiccant system consisting of two evaporative coolers and heat and desiccant wheels for a 100% replacement air application, as shown in Figure 46, could provide all the space summer cooling needs without the use of an air conditioner. Such a system can reduce net electrical power requirements by more than 90% at design conditions for the city of Phoenix, Arizona (Dhamshala 2016). The only electrical power required is for the fan power and rotation of the wheels. The magnitude of estimated electrical power savings should be of similar range for the entire dry (B) region of the ASHRAE climatic zones, with small differences.

Note that the minuscule heat energy required (6.15 kW) in the heater can easily be obtained from an air-to-air heat exchanger using

outdoor air (which, at 39.4°C, exceeds the minimum temperature) before it enters the desiccant wheel. The cost of water supplied to the evaporative coolers is estimated to be negligible.

Accurate estimates of energy cost savings over a year can be obtained through detailed computer simulations of systems for a specific building with given building loads using the hourly weather data. Highly specialized desiccant systems using a DOAS can be designed to serve the buildings with specific loads or needs (Moffitt 2015). Sultan et al. (2015) provide an overview of various widely used solid-desiccant air systems.

In the case that outdoor air requirements are less than 100%, use of direct evaporative coolers adds more humidity into the supply air. An alternative to replace the direct evaporative cooler is the indirect evaporative cooler (M-cycle), as shown in Figure 47 for the cooling season, which has a potential to save 32% of cooling capacity, while the system shown in Figure 48 (suitable for winter heating) has a potential to save 22% of heating costs.

These systems are particularly suitable for sustainable systems, where the emphasis is placed on the use of renewable energy resources such as solar, wind, and bioenergy. A PV/T panel system in combination with water-to-water heat pump, absorption chiller, and thermal storage can provide the energy requirements for cooling and heating seasons.

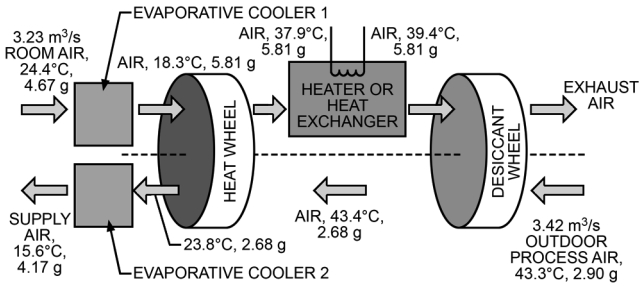

Fig. 46 Dessicant System of Evaporative Coolers and Heat and Dessicant Wheels

However, these systems are also suitable if renewable energy resources are not available at the site. The heat energy required by the heater placed between the heat and desiccant wheels to regenerate the air can be obtained from the condenser of the air-conditioner, similar to the system shown in Figure 14.

Sustainability. Recently, due to climate change, greater emphasis has been on reducing the greenhouse gas emissions (UN Climate Change Report; UNFCCC 2018), and on the rapid adoption of renewable energy resources. In light of the urgent need, the systems shown in Figures 47 and 48pave the way to accommodate the use of renewable energy resources to meet the future goals of the HVAC systems to be compatible with smart grid applications. The desiccant and heat wheels shown in Figures 47 and 48 and not only perform the energy recovery from the outgoing exhaust air but also meet the peak loads of the building through proper selection of flow rates, mixing of outdoor air with exhaust air, and regenerating temperature. Several other options of these variations may be possible to suit the level of regenerating temperatures.

Ge et al. (2015), Tu et al. (2015), and Zeng et al. (2014) find that two-stage desiccant systems can be designed to use low-grade heat energy resources, such as waste energy at the site or solar collectors, which can yield greater energy cost savings.

To best use existing energy resources available at a specific temperature or grade, perform a series of second-law analyses on a variety of desiccant systems (including a two-stage unit) to find the maximum energy cost savings and to identify the components of the system that have largest exergy destruction (Enteria et al. 2013; Liu et al. 2016; Tu et al. 2015a, 2015b).

An emerging technology combining liquid-desiccant solutions (e.g., lithium chloride) with an evaporative cooler has the potential to save significant energy costs (Gao et al. 2015). A simplified schematic suitable for use in various climates is shown in Figure 49.

Note that the minuscule heat energy required (6.15 kW) in the heater can easily be obtained from an air-to-air heat exchanger using outdoor air (which, at 39.4°C, exceeds the minimum temperature) before it enters the desiccant wheel. The cost of water supplied to the evaporative coolers is estimated to be negligible.

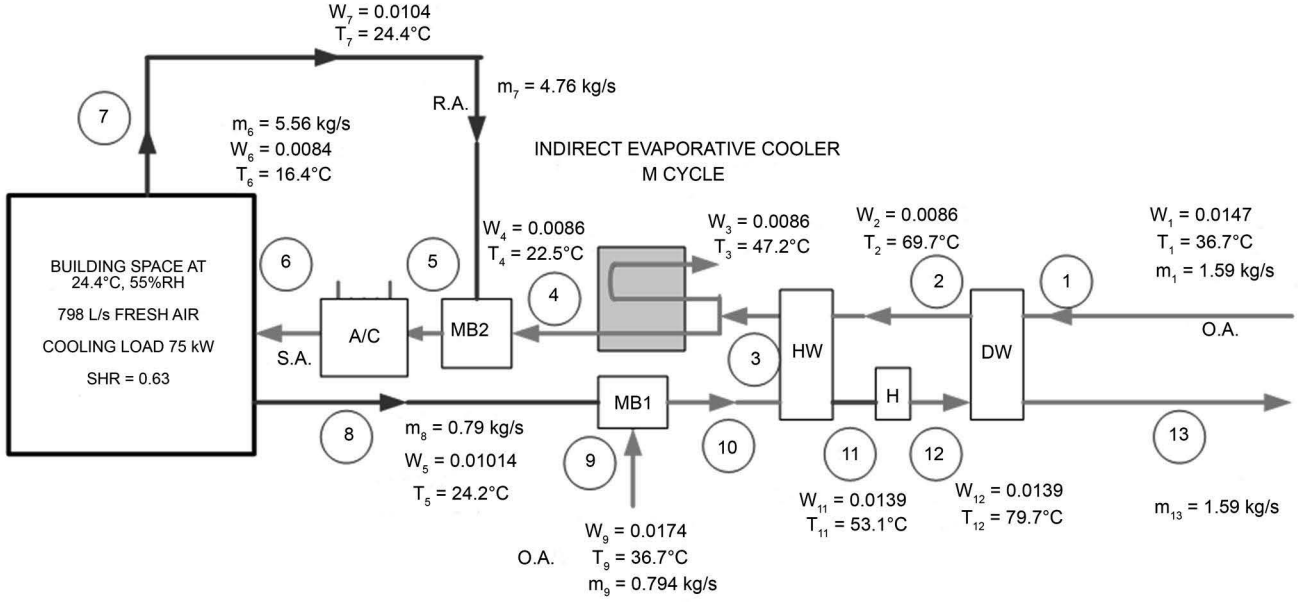

Fig. 47 Dessicant and Heat Wheels with Indirect Evaporative Cooler (M-Cyle)

Dhamshala et al. (2019)

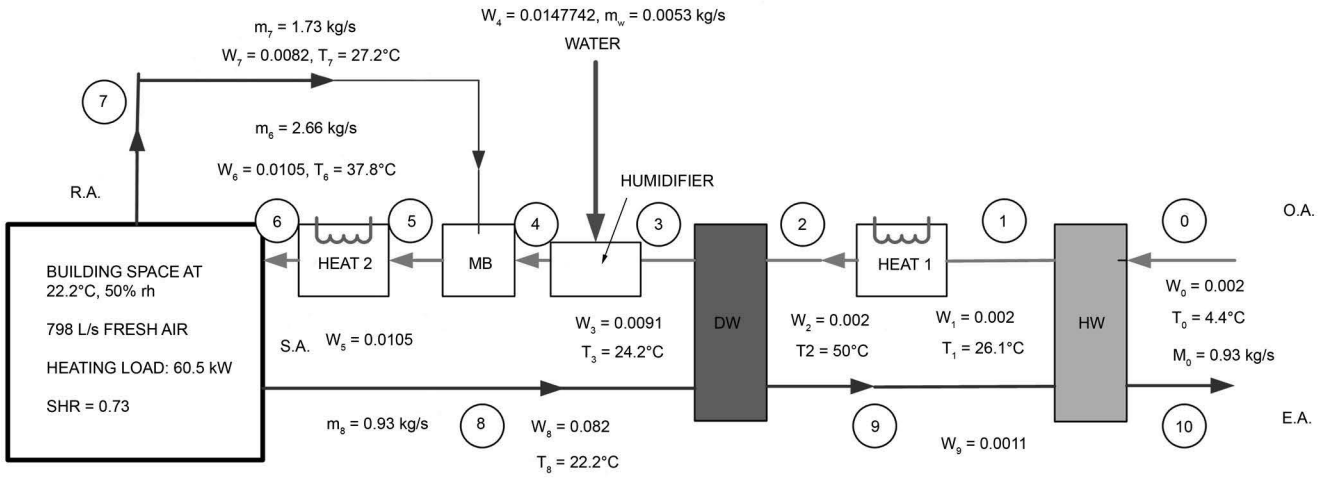

Fig. 48 Dessicant and Heat Wheels with Humidifier for Winter Heating

Dhamshala et al. (2019)

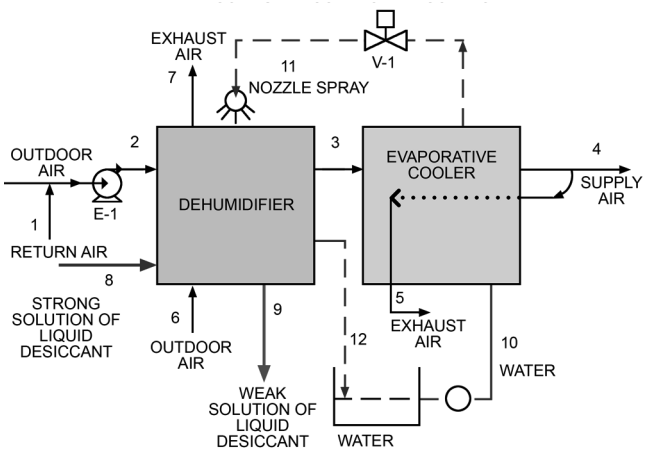

Fig. 49 Schematic of Liquid Dessicant System and Evaporative Cooler

NREL

Heat energy is required to regenerate the liquid desiccant solution; it can use waste heat energy, if available at the site, or use solar collectors. A combination of heat and desiccant wheels with this liquid-desiccant system might provide an economical system that is environmentally friendly.

8. ECONOMIC CONSIDERATIONS

Air-to-air energy recovery systems are used in both new and retrofit applications. These systems should be designed for the maximum cost benefit or least life-cycle cost (LCC) expressed either over the service life or annually and with an acceptable payback period.

The annualized system owning, operating, and maintenance costs are discussed in Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*. Although the capital cost and interest term in this method imply a simple value, it is in fact a complex function of the future value of money as well as all the design variables in the energy/heat exchanger. These variables include the mass of each material used, cost of forming these materials into a highly effective energy/heat exchanger, cost of auxiliary equipment and controls, and cost of installation.

The **operating energy cost** for energy recovery systems involves functions integrated over time, including variables such as flow rate, pressure drop, fan efficiency, energy cost, and energy recovery rate. The calculations are complex because air-heating and/or cooling loads are, for a range of supply temperatures, time dependent in most buildings. Time-of-use schedules for buildings can impose different ventilation rates for each hour of the day. Electrical utility charges often vary with time of day, amount of energy used, and peak power load. For building ventilation air-heating applications, the peak heat recovery rate usually occurs at the outdoor supply temperature at which frosting control throttling must be imposed. In addition to designing for the winter design temperature, heat recovery systems should be optimized for peak heat recovery rate, taking frost control into account.

Overall exchanger effectiveness ε should be high (see Table 3 for typical values); however, a high ε implies a high capital cost, even when the exchanger is designed to minimize the amount of materials used. Energy costs for fans and pumps are usually very important and accumulate operating cost even when the energy recovery system must be throttled back. For building ventilation, throttling may be required much of the time. Thus, the overall LCC minimization problem for optimal design may involve 10 or more independent design variables as well as several specified constraints and operating conditions (see, e.g., Besant and Johnson [1995]).

In addition, comfort-to-comfort energy recovery systems often operate with much smaller temperature differences than most auxiliary air-heating and cooling heat exchangers. These small temperature differences need more accurate energy transfer models to reach the maximum cost benefit or lowest LCC. Most importantly, recovered energy at design may be used to reduce the required capacity of heating and cooling equipment, which can be significant in both system performance/efficiency and economics.

The **payback period (PP)** is best computed after the annualized costs have been evaluated. It is usually defined as

$$\begin{aligned} \text{PP} &= \frac{\text{Capital cost and interest}}{\text{Annual operating enery cost saved}} \\ &= \frac{C_{s,init} - \text{ITC}}{C_e(1 - T_{inc})}\text{CRF}(i'', n) \end{aligned} \tag{29}$$

where

$C_{s,\,init}$ = initial system cost

ITC = investment tax credit for energy-efficient improvements
C_e = cost of energy to operate the system for one period
T_{inc} = net income tax rate where rates are based on last dollar earned (i.e., marginal rates) = (local + state + federal rate) – (federal rate) (local + state rate)
CRF = capital recovery factor
i'' = effective discount rate adjusted for energy inflation
n = total number of periods under analysis

The inverse of this term is usually called the **return on investment (ROI).** Well-designed energy recovery systems normally have a PP of less than 5 years, and often less than 3 years. Paybacks of less than 1 year are not uncommon in comfort-to-comfort applications in hot, humid climates, primarily because of the reduced size of cooling equipment required.

Other economic factors include the following.

System Installed Cost. Initial installed HVAC system cost is often lower for air-to-air energy recovery devices because mechanical refrigeration and fuel-fired heating equipment can be reduced in size. Thus, a more efficient HVAC system may also have a lower installed total HVAC cost. The installed cost of heat recovery systems becomes lower per unit of flow as the amount of outdoor air used for ventilation increases.

Life-Cycle Cost. Air-to-air energy recovery cost benefits are best evaluated considering all capital, installation, operating, and energy-saving costs over the equipment life under normal operating conditions in terms of the life-cycle cost. As a rule, neither the most efficient nor the least expensive energy recovery device will be most economical. Optimizing the life-cycle cost for maximum net savings may involve many design variables, requiring careful cost estimates and use of an accurate recovery system model with all its design variables (see, e.g., Besant and Simonson [2000]).

Energy Costs. The absolute cost of energy and relative costs of various energy forms are major economic factors. High energy costs favor high levels of energy recovery. In regions where electrical costs are high relative to fuel prices, heat recovery devices with low pressure drops are preferable.

Amount of Recoverable Energy. Economies of scale favor large installations. Equipment is commercially available for air-to-air energy recovery applications using 25 L/s and above.

Grade of Exhaust Energy. High-grade (i.e., high-temperature) exhaust energy is generally more economical to recover than low-grade energy. Energy recovery is most economical for large temperature differences between the waste energy source and destination.

Coincidence and Duration of Waste Heat Supply and Demand. Energy recovery is most economical when supply coincides with demand and both are relatively constant throughout the year. Thermal storage may be used to store energy if supply and demand are not coincident, but this adds cost and complexity to the system.

Proximity of Supply to Demand. Applications with a large central energy source and a nearby waste energy use are more favorable than applications with several scattered waste energy sources and uses.

Operating Environment. High operating temperatures or the presence of corrosives, condensable gases, and particulates in either airstream results in higher equipment and maintenance costs. Increased equipment costs result from the use of corrosion- or temperature-resistant materials, and maintenance costs are incurred by an increase in the frequency of equipment repair and wash down and additional air filtration requirements.

Effect on Pollution Control Systems. Removing process heat may reduce the cost of pollution control systems by (1) allowing less expensive filter bags to be used, (2) improving the efficiency of electronic precipitators, or (3) condensing out contaminant vapors, thus reducing the load on downstream pollution control systems. In some applications, recovered condensable gases may be returned to the process for reuse.

Effect on Heating and Cooling Equipment. Heat recovery equipment may reduce the size requirements for primary utility equipment such as boilers, chillers, and burners, as well as the size of piping and electrical services to them. Larger fans and fan motors (and hence fan energy) are generally required to overcome increased static pressure loss caused by the energy recovery devices. Auxiliary heaters may be required for frost control.

Effect on Humidifying or Dehumidifying Equipment. Selecting total energy recovery equipment results in the transfer of moisture from the airstream with the greater humidity ratio to the airstream with the lesser humidity ratio. This is desirable in many situations because humidification costs are reduced in cold weather and dehumidification loads are reduced in warm weather.

9. ENERGY AND/OR MASS RECOVERY CALCULATION PROCEDURE

The rate of energy transfer to or from an airstream depends on the rate and direction of heat transfer and water vapor (moisture) transfer. Under customary design conditions, heat and water vapor transfer will be in the same direction, but the rate of heat transfer often will not be the same as the rate of energy transfer by the cross-stream flow of water vapor. This is because the driving potentials for heat and mass transfer are different, as are the respective wall resistances for the two types of transport. Both transfer rates depend on exchanger construction characteristics.

The following general procedure may be used to determine the performance and energy recovered in air-to-air energy recovery applications at each operating condition.

Step 1. Determine supply and exhaust air pressure drops Δp_s and Δp_e across exchanger.

Request air pressure drops Δp_s and Δp_e across the heat or energy exchanger from the manufacturer, who may have certified AHRI *Standard* 1061 test condition data obtained using ASHRAE *Standard* 84 as a test procedure and analysis guide. These data may be extrapolated to non-AHRI conditions by the manufacturer using correlations such as Equations (12) or (13), if their restrictions are satisfied. For other flow conditions, somewhat different correlations may be more accurate to determine the pressure drop.

Step 2. Calculate theoretical maximum moisture and energy transfer rates m_{max} and q_{max}.

The airstream with the lower mass flow m_{min} limits heat and moisture transfer. Some designers specify and prefer working with airflows stated at standard temperature and pressure conditions. To correctly calculate moisture or energy transfer rates, the designer must determine mass flow rates. For this reason, the designer must know whether airflow rates are quoted for the entry conditions specified or at standard temperature and pressure conditions. If necessary, convert flow rates to mass flow rates (e.g., L/s or m^3/s at standard temperature and pressure to kg/s) and then determine which airstream has the minimum mass.

The theoretical maximum sensible heat, latent heat and total energy rates are given by the denominators of Equations (2a), (2b), and (2c), respectively.

The split between latent and sensible energy can be determined by plotting airstream conditions on a psychrometric chart as shown in Figure 50. Maximum sensible heat transfer is represented by a horizontal line drawn between the two dry-bulb temperatures, and maximum latent energy transfer is represented by the vertical line.

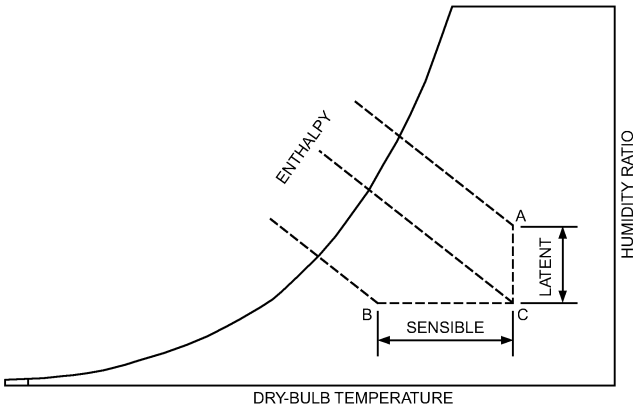

Fig. 50 Maximum Sensible and Latent Heat from Process A-B

Step 3. Establish moisture, sensible, and total effectiveness ε_s, ε_L, and ε_t.

Each of these ratios is obtained from manufacturers' product data using input conditions and airflows for both airstreams. The effectiveness for airflows depends on (1) exchanger construction, including configuration, heat transfer material, moisture transfer properties, transfer surface area, airflow path, distance between heat transfer surfaces, and overall size; and (2) inlet conditions for both airstreams, including pressures, velocities, temperatures, and humidities. In applications with unequal airflow rates, the enthalpy change will be higher for the airstream with the lesser mass flow.

Step 4. Calculate actual moisture (latent) and energy (sensible, latent or total) transfer rates.

The actual moisture, sensible heat, latent heat, and total energy rates are given by Equations (5a), (5b), (5c), and (5d or 5e), respectively.

Step 5. Calculate leaving air properties for each airstream using Equations (4a), (4b), (4c), (4d), (4e), and (4f).

With an enthalpy or moisture-permeable heat exchanger, moisture (and its inherent latent energy) is transferred between airstreams. With a sensible-only heat exchanger, if the warmer airstream is cooled below its dew point, the resulting condensed moisture transfers additional energy. When condensation occurs, latent heat is released, maintaining that airstream at a higher temperature than if condensation had not occurred. This higher air temperature (potential flux) increases the heat transfer to the other airstream. The sensible and total effectiveness are widely used because the energy flow in the condensate is relatively small in most applications. (Freezing and frosting are unsteady conditions that should be avoided unless a defrost cycle is included.) Equations (4c) and (4d) must be used to calculate the leaving air humidity conditions, and Equations (4e) and (4f) to calculate the enthalpy values for airstreams in which inherent latent energy transfer occurs. Equations (4a) and (4b) may be used for airstreams if only sensible energy transfer is involved.

Step 6. Check energy transfer balance between airstreams.

Equation (5a) can be used to estimate the sensible energy transfer rate into the supply airstream, and can be adapted to estimate the energy transfer rate out of the exhaust airstream by substituting T_3 for T_1, and substituting T_4 for T_2. Equation (5d) or (5e) can estimate the total energy for the two airstreams, using similar substitutions. Total energy transferred from one airstream should equal total heat transferred to the other. Calculate and compare the energy transferred to or from each airstream. Differences between these energy flows are usually because of measurement errors.

Step 7. Plot entering and leaving conditions on psychrometric chart.

Examine the plotted information for each airstream to verify that performance is reasonable and accurate.

(*Steps 8 to 10 apply only when EATR ≠ 0 and OACF ≠ 1.*)

Step 8. Obtain data on exhaust air transfer ratio (EATR > 0 and typically 0.05 > EATR > 0 for regenerative wheels).

Request the EATR data from the manufacturer, who may have certified AHRI *Standard* 1061 test condition data obtained using ASHRAE *Standard* 84 as a test procedure and analysis guide. These data may be extrapolated to non-AHRI test conditions using correlations relating EATR to air pressure differences between the supply and exhaust and, for rotary regenerative wheels, carryover caused by wheel rotation. Shang et al. (2001a) show that, for regenerative wheels, a correlation may be developed between EATR and carryover ratio, R_c, and OACF, but for other air-to-air exchangers EATR will be very small or negligible.

Step 9. Obtain data on outdoor air correction factor (OACF ≈ 1 and typically 0.9 < OACF < 1.1 for regenerative wheels).

Request the OACF data from the manufacturer, who may have certified AHRI *Standard* 1061 test condition data obtained using ASHRAE *Standard* 84 as a test procedure and analysis guide. These data may be extrapolated to non-AHRI test conditions using correlations relating OACF to pressure differences (Shang et al. 2001b), for regenerative wheels; for other exchangers, OACF will be very nearly 1.0.

Step 10. Correct the supply air ventilation rate, moisture transfer rate, and energy transfer rates for EATR ≠ 0 and OACF ≠ 1.0.

Values of EATR significantly larger than zero and OACF significantly different than 1.0 imply the air-to-air exchanger is transferring air between the exhaust and supply airstreams. This transfer may be important, especially for some devices such as regenerative wheels. Shang et al. (2001b) show a method to correct the energy rates when EATR ≠ 0 and OACF ≠ 1. The procedure to correct the supply air ventilation rate is shown in Example 8.

Example 5. Sensible Heat Recovery in Winter. Exhaust air at 23°C and 10% rh with a flow rate of 6 kg/s preheats an equal mass flow rate of outdoor air at –18°C and 60% rh (ρ = 1.39 kg/m^3) using an air-to-air heat exchanger with a measured effectiveness of 60%. Airflows are specified as mass flow rates at standard temperature and pressure (i.e., 15°C and 101.325 kPa). Assuming EATR = 0 and OACF ≈ 1, determine the leaving supply air temperatures and energy recovered, and check the heat exchange balance. To simplify the calculation, assume that specific heat of dry air is constant at 1 kJ/kg·K

Solution:

Note: the numbers correspond to the steps in the calculation procedure.

1. Because data on pressure drop are missing, skip this step.

2. Calculate the theoretical maximum heat transfer.

The two inlet conditions plotted on a psychrometric chart (Figure 51) indicate that, because the exhaust air has low relative humidity, latent energy transfer does not occur. Using the denominator of Equation (2a), the theoretical maximum sensible heat transfer rate q_s is

$$q_{max} = (6\ \text{kg/s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}][23 - (-18)] = 246\ \text{kW}$$

3. Establish the sensible effectiveness.

From manufacturer's literature and certified performance test data, effectiveness is determined to be 60% at the design conditions.

4. Calculate actual heat transfer at given conditions.

Using Equation (5a),

$$q_s = (0.6)(246)\ \text{kW} = 148\ \text{kW}$$

5. Calculate leaving air conditions.

Because no moisture or latent energy transfer will occur,

a. Leaving supply air temperature t_2 is given as

$$t_2 = -18°\text{C} + \frac{148\ \text{kW}}{(6\ \text{kg/s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}]} = 6.7°\text{C}$$

b. Leaving exhaust air temperature t_4 is given as

$$t_4 = 23°\text{C} - \frac{148\ \text{kW}}{(6\ \text{kg/s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}]} = -1.7°\text{C}$$

6. Using Equation (5a), check performance.

$$q_s = (6\ \text{kg/s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}][6.7 - (-18)] = 148\ \text{kW saved}$$

7. Plot conditions on psychrometric chart to confirm that no moisture exchange occurred (Figure 52).

Because EATR = 0 and OACF ≈ 1, Steps 8 to 10 of the calculation procedure are not presented here.

Example 6. Sensible Heat Recovery in Winter with Water Vapor Condensation. Exhaust air at 23°C and 28% rh (ρ = 1.2 kg/m^3) and flow rate of 5 m^3/s is used to preheat 4.5 m^3/s of outdoor air at –10°C and 50% rh (ρ = 1.34 kg/m^3) using a heat exchanger with a sensible effectiveness of 70%. Assuming EATR = 0 and OACF ≈ 1, determine the leaving supply air conditions and energy recovered, and check the energy exchange balance.

Solution:

The supply airstream has a lower airflow rate than the exhaust airstream, so it may appear that the supply airstream limits heat transfer. However, determination of mass flow rates for the given entry conditions shows that the mass flow rate of the supply airstream (6.03 kg/s) is slightly greater than that of the exhaust airstream (6.0 kg/s), so exhaust is the limiting airstream. Nevertheless, because the mass difference is negligible, it is convenient to use supply air volume as the limiting airstream. Also, to simplify the calculation, assume that specific heat of dry air is constant at 1 kj/kg·K.

1. Because data on pressure drop are missing, skip this step.

2. Calculate the theoretical maximum sensible heat transfer.

The limiting airstream, the supply airstream, will be preheated in the heat exchanger, so it is not subject to condensation. Therefore, the denominator of Equation (2a) is used:

$$q_{max} = (4.5\ \text{m}^3\text{/s})(1.34\ \text{kg/m}^3)[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}][23 - (-10)]°\text{C} = 199\ \text{kW}$$

3. Select sensible effectiveness.

From manufacturer's literature and performance test data, the sensible effectiveness is determined to be 70% at the design conditions.

4. Calculate actual heat transfer at design conditions using Equation (5a):

$$q_s = (0.7)(199\ \text{kW}) = 139\ \text{kW}$$

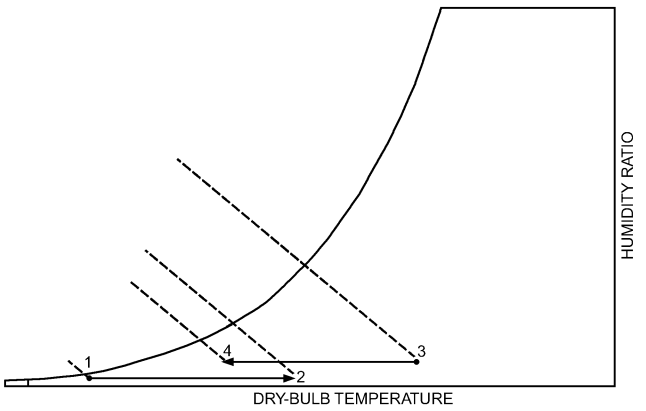

Fig. 51 Sensible Heat Recovery in Winter (Example 5)

5. Calculate leaving air conditions.

a. Leaving supply air temperature is calculated by

$$t_2 = -10°\text{C} + \left\{\frac{139\ \text{kW}}{(1.34\ \text{kg/m}^3)(4.5\ \text{m}^3\text{/s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}]}\right\} = 13.1°\text{C}$$

b. Because the dew point of exhaust air at inlet is 3.54°C, condensation occurs on the exhaust side, so the leaving exhaust air temperature cannot be determined using Equation (4b). The entering exhaust air enthalpy and humidity ratio are determined for the dry-bulb temperature of 23°C and 28% rh using a psychrometric chart and found to be h_3 = 36 kJ/kg and w_3 = 0.0052 kg/kg. However, the leaving exhaust air enthalpy can be determined by

$$h_4 = 36\ \text{kJ/kg} - \left[\frac{139\ \text{kW}}{(1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)(5\ \text{m}^3\text{/s})}\right] = 12.83\ \text{kJ/kg}$$

Because the air will be saturated at the outlet of exhaust air, the dry-bulb or wet-bulb temperature and humidity ratio corresponding to an enthalpy of 12.83 kJ/kg is found to be t_4 = 1.4°C and w_4 = 0.0044 kg/kg. The rate of moisture condensed m_w is

$$m_w = m_e\,(w_3 - w_4) = (6\ \text{kg/s})(0.0049 - 0.0042) = 0.0042\ \text{kg/s}$$

6. Check performance.

$$q_s = (134\ \text{kg/m}^3)(4.5\ \text{m}^3\text{/s})[0.24\ \text{kJ/(kg·°C)}][13.1 - (-10)]$$
$$= 139.3\ \text{kW saved}$$

Neglect the enthalpy of the condensed water by adding the energy lost through condensation of vapor to the sensible heat lost of the exhausting air.

$$q_e = (1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)(5\ \text{m}^3\text{/s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}][23 - 1.4)]$$
$$+ (0.0042\ \text{kg/s})(2560\ \text{kJ/kg})$$
$$= 140.35\ \text{kW saved, which is very close to } 139.3\ \text{kW}$$

7. Plot conditions on psychrometric chart (Figure 53). Note that moisture condenses in the exhaust side of the heat exchanger.

Because EATR = 0 and OACF ≈ 1, Steps 8 to 10 of the calculation procedure are not presented here.

Example 7. Total Heat Recovery in Summer. Exhaust air at 23°C and 17°C wb (ρ = 1.2 kg/m^3) with a flow rate of 5 m^3/s is used to precool 4 m^3/s of supply outdoor air at 35°C and 27°C wb (ρ = 1.15 kg/m^3) using a hygroscopic total energy exchanger. The sensible and total effectiveness for this heat exchanger are 70 and 56.7%, respectively. Assuming EATR = 0 and OACF ≈ 1, determine the leaving supply air conditions and energy recovered, and check the energy exchange balance. To simplify the calculation, assume that specific heat of dry air is constant at 1 kJ/kg·K.

Solution:

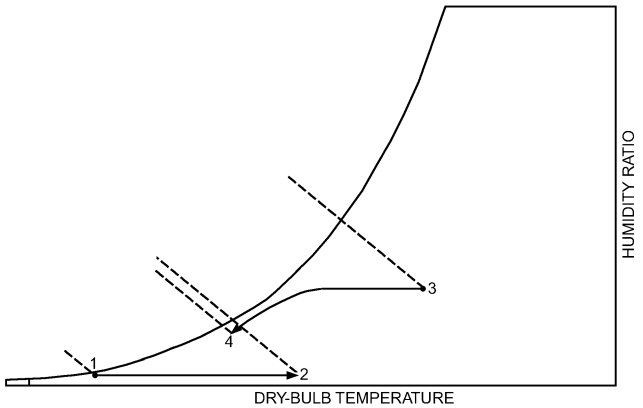

Fig. 52 Sensible Heat Recovery in Winter with Condensate (Example 5)

1. Because data on pressure drop are missing, skip this step.
2. Calculate the theoretical maximum heat transfer.

The supply airstream is a lesser or limiting airstream for energy and moisture transfer. Determine entering airstream enthalpies and humidity ratio from psychrometric chart.

Supply inlet (35°C db, 27°C wb) $h_1 = 85.2$ kJ/kg $w_1 = 0.0194$ kg/kg

Exhaust inlet (23°C db, 17°C wb) $h_3 = 47.8$ kJ/kg $w_3 = 0.0093$ kg/kg

The theoretical maximum sensible and total heat transfer rates can be obtained as follows:

$$q_{max}\,(\text{sensible}) = (1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}](35 - 23) = 55.2\ \text{kW}$$

$$q_{max}\,(\text{total energy}) = (1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})(85.2 - 47.8) = 172\ \text{kW}$$

3. Determine supply sensible and total effectiveness.

The manufacturer's selection data for the design conditions provide the following effectiveness ratios:

$$\varepsilon_s = 70\% \qquad \varepsilon_t = 56.7\%$$

4. Calculate energy transfer at design conditions.

$$q_t = (0.567)(172\ \text{kW}) = 97.52\ \text{kW total recovered}$$
$$q_s = -(0.7)(55.2\ \text{kW}) = -38.64\ \text{kW sensible recovered}$$
$$q_{tat} = 58.8\ \text{kW latent recovered}$$

5. Calculate leaving air conditions.

a. Supply air conditions

$$t_2 = 35°\text{C} + \frac{-38.64\ \text{kW}}{(1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}]} = 26.6°\text{C}$$

$$h_2 = 85.2\ \text{kJ/kg} + \frac{-97.52\ \text{kW}}{(1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})} = 64\ \text{kJ/kg}$$

From the psychrometric chart, the supply air humidity ratio and wet-bulb temperature are found to be $w_2 = 0.0145$ and $t_{w2} = 21.8°\text{C}$.

b. Exhaust air conditions

$$t_4 = 23°\text{C} + \frac{38.64\ \text{kW}}{(1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)(5\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}]} = 29.4°\text{C}$$

$$h_4 = 47.8\ \text{kJ/kg} + \frac{97.52\ \text{kW}}{(1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)(5\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})} = 64.1\ \text{kJ/kg} = 64.1\ \text{kJ/kg}$$

From the psychrometric chart, the exhaust humidity ratio and wet-bulb temperature are found to be $w_4 = 0.0134$ and $t_{w4} = 21.8°\text{C}$.

6. Check total performance (Equation 5d).

$$q_t = (1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})(85.2 - 64) = 97.52\ \text{kW saved}$$

$$q_t = (1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)(5\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})\{[1\ \text{kJ/(kg · K)}](29.4 - 23) + (0.013 - 0.0093)(2560\ \text{kJ/kg})\} = 95.23\ \text{kW, which is close to 94.1 kW}$$

7. Plot conditions on psychrometric chart (Figure 54).

Because EATR = 0 and OACF ≈ 1, Steps 8 to 10 are not presented here.

Example 8. Total Energy Recovery with EATR ≠ 0 and OACF ≠ 1.0. An ERV manufacturer claims a product has performance characteristics as shown here at 400 L/s:

Pressure drop $\Delta p = 225$ Pa
$\varepsilon_{sensible} = 0.73$
$\varepsilon_{latent} = 0.68$
$\varepsilon_{total} = 0.715$

A building has a ventilation requirement of 400 L/s and exhaust air at 23°C and 17°C wb ($\rho = 1.2$ kg/m^3) is used to precool supply outdoor air at 35°C and 27°C wb ($\rho = 1.15$ kg/m^3).

(a) Assuming EATR = 0 and OACF ≈ 1, determine the leaving supply air conditions and energy recovered, and check the energy exchange balance.

(b) Assuming EATR = 5% and OACF = 1.05, determine the actual airflow rates.

In both cases, to simplify the calculation, assume that specific heat of dry air is constant at 1 kj/kg·K.

Solution:

1. From the manufacturer's claims, at a flow rate of 400 L/s, the pressure drop $\Delta p = 225$ Pa. Assuming the effective efficiency of the fan motor combination is about 0.6, the power P_s required to circulate the supply air can be obtained from Equation (8) as

$$P_s = (400\ \text{L/s})(1\ \text{m}^3/1000\ \text{L})(225\ \text{Pa})/(0.6) = 150\ \text{W or } 0.15\ \text{kW}$$

Assuming the balanced flow the power required to circulate the exhaust air would be same, therefore the total power P required to circulate the airstreams would be twice this amount.

$$P = 300\ \text{W or } 0.3\ \text{kW}$$

2. Calculate the theoretical maximum heat transfer.

Determine entering airstream enthalpies and humidity ratio from the psychrometric chart.

Supply inlet (35°C db, 27°C wb) $h_1 = 85.2$ kJ/kg $w_1 = 0.0194$ kg/kg

Exhaust inlet (23°C db, 17°C wb) $h_3 = 47.8$ kJ/kg $w_3 = 0.0093$ kg/kg

The theoretical maximum heat transfer rates can be obtained as follows:

$$q_{max}(\text{sensible}) = (1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(400\ \text{L/s})(1\ \text{m}^3/1000\ \text{L}) \times [1\ \text{kJ/(kg · K)}](35 - 23) = 5.52\ \text{kW}$$

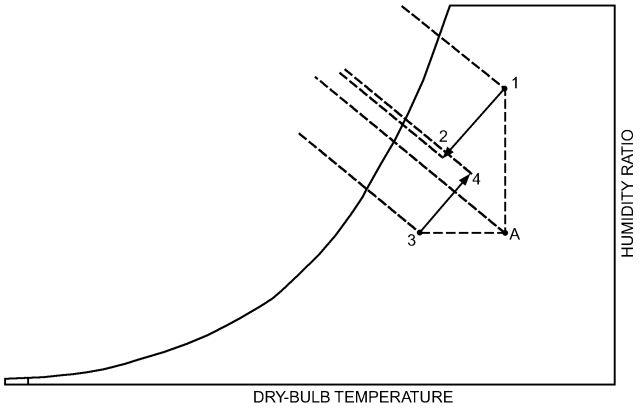

Fig. 53 Total Heat Recovery in Summer (Example 6)

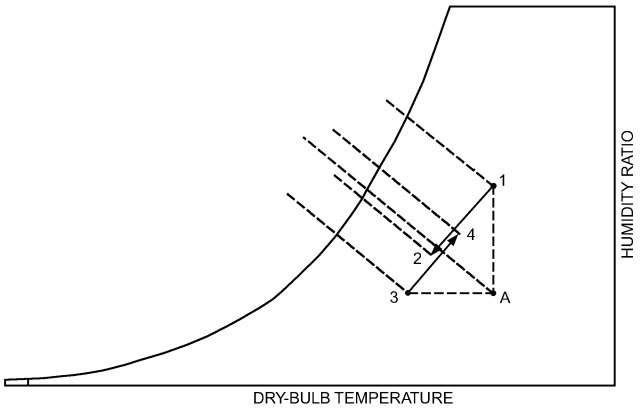

Fig. 54 Total Energy Recovery with EATR ≠ 0 and OACF ≠ 1 (Example 7)

$$q_{max}(\text{latent}) = (1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(400\ \text{L/s})(1\ \text{m}^3/1000\ \text{L}) \times (2560\ \text{kJ/kg})(0.0194 - 0.0093) = 11.89\ \text{kW}$$

$$q_{max}(\text{total}) = (1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(400\ \text{L/s})(1\ \text{m}^3/1000\ \text{L}) \times (85.2 - 47.8) = 17.2\ \text{kW}$$

Note that sum of sensible and latent energy should equal the total energy.

3. Determine supply sensible and total effectiveness.

From the manufacturer's claims, at a flow rate of 400 L/s, $\varepsilon_s = 0.73$, $\varepsilon_L = 0.68$, and $\varepsilon_t = 0.715$.

4. Calculate energy transfer at design conditions.

$$q_s = (0.73)(5.52\ \text{kW}) = 4.03\ \text{kW sensible recovered}$$

$$q_L = (0.68)(11.89\ \text{kW}) = 8.09\ \text{kW latent recovered}$$

$$q_t = (0.715)(17.2\ \text{kW}) = 12.3\ \text{kW total recovered}$$

5. Calculate leaving air conditions.

a. Supply air conditions

$$t_2 = 35°\text{C} + \frac{-4.03\ \text{kW}}{(1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(0.4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}]} = 26.2°\text{C}$$

$$h_2 = 85.2\ \text{kJ/kg} + \frac{-12.3\ \text{kW}}{(1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(0.4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})} = 58.5\ \text{kJ/kg}$$

From the psychrometric chart, the supply air humidity ratio and wet-bulb temperature are $w_2 = 0.0129$ and $t_{w2} = 20.2°\text{C}$.

b. Exhaust air conditions

$$t_4 = 23°\text{C} + \frac{4.03\ \text{kW}}{(1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)(0.4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}]} = 31.4°\text{C}$$

$$h_4 = 47.8\ \text{kJ/kg} + \frac{12.3\ \text{kW}}{(1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)(0.4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})} = 73.43\ \text{kJ/kg}$$

From the psychrometric chart, the exhaust humidity ratio and wet-bulb temperature are found to be $w_4 = 0.0164$, $t_{w4} = 24.2°\text{C}$.

6. Check total performance.

$$q_t = (1.15\ \text{kg/m}^3)(0.4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})(85.2 - 58.5) = 12.28\ \text{kW saved}$$

$$q_t = (1.2\ \text{kg/m}^3)\ (0.4\ \text{m}^3/\text{s})\{[1\ \text{kJ/(kg·K)}](31.4 - 23) + (0.0164 - 0.0093)(2560\ \text{kJ/kg})\} = 12.7\ \text{kW},$$
which is close to 12.28 kW

7. Plot conditions on psychrometric chart (Figure 54).

8. Obtain data on EATR. (Given: EATR = 5% or 0.05.)

9. Obtain data on OACF. (Given: OACF = 1.05.)

10. Correct the supply air ventilation rate, the moisture transfer rate, and energy transfer rates EATR ≠ 0 and OACF ≠ 1.0.

The net ventilation rate is 400 L/s and the EATR = 0.05; therefore, the actual flow rate Q_2 to the space can be obtained from Equation (19) as

$$Q_3 = Q_2 = \frac{Q_v}{1 - (\text{EATR}/100)} = \frac{400\ \text{L/s}}{1 - 5/100} = 421\ \text{L/s}$$

Because OACF = 1.05, the actual flow rate Q_1 of fresh air from outdoor can be calculated from Equation (21) as

$$Q_1 = Q_2(\text{OACF})\frac{Q_v(\text{OACF})}{1 - (\text{EATR}/100)} = \frac{(400\ \text{L/s})(1.05)}{1 - 5/100} = 442\ \text{L/s}$$

To balance the flow rates into the ERV, the actual air flow rates at states 3 and 4 are as shown in Figure 55.

Supply and exhaust fan capacity should match the flows required at their locations. Example 8's results are for balanced flow. Assuming flow rates in the ERV are same as the outdoor air ventilation requirements, then the effectiveness would be same as that for no air leakage. If air leaks at the inlet and outlet of the energy recovery ventilator, then the exit conditions of air temperature and humidity at states 3 and 4 can be calculated as those of the airstream mixture. For instance, the properties at state 2 would be those of an airstream mixture at state 2 for no air leakage and air quantity (Q_{32}) at state 3. The error for these calculations should be less than 5%.

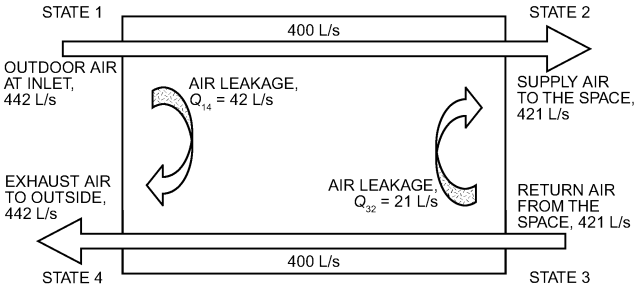

Fig. 55 Actual Airflow Rates at Various State Points (Example 8)

Shang et al. (2001a) show a method to accurately estimate the energy rates when EATR ≠ 0 and OACF ≠ 1.

10. SYMBOLS

A = area of recovery exchanger, m^2
c_p = specific heat of moist air, kJ/(kg·K)
C = capital cost
C_e = cost of energy
C_p = specific heat of air kJ/(kg·K)
C_r = ratio of C_{min}/C_{max}
$C_{s,int}$ = initial system capital cost
CRF = capital recovery factor
h = enthalpy, kJ/kg
h_{fg} = enthalpy of vaporization, kJ/kg
i = arbitrary state, or discount rate
ITC = income tax credit
m_s = mass flow rate of supply moist air from outdoors, kg/s
m_e = mass flow rate of exhaust moist air, kg/s
m_{min} = minimum mass flow rate of supply and exhaust airstreams, kg/s
n = number of years in economic consideration, years
NTU = number of transfer units = UA/C_{min}
p = pressure, Pa
pp = payback period, years
P = pumping power, W or kW
q = heat transfer rate, W or kW
Q = volume flow rate, m^3/s
S = reference temperature, K
t = moist air temperature at state i, °C
t_{w3} = wet-bulb temperature of moist air at state 3, °C
T = absolute temperature, K, or tax
U = overall heat transfer coefficient, $\text{W/(m}^2\text{·K)}$
V = mean velocity, m/s
w = humidity ratio

Greek Letters

ε_s = sensible effectiveness of heat or energy wheel
ε_L = latent effectiveness of energy wheel
ε_t = total effectiveness of ERV
η = efficiency
ρ = density, kg/m^3
σ = volume fraction
ϕ = relative humidity
ω = rotational speed of the wheel, rpm

Subscripts

a = air
e = exhaust side of heat/energy exchanger, exit or energy
f = fan or fan motor combination
if = threshold temperature of the outdoor air for freezing to occur
in = indoor conditions of building space
inc = increment
h = hydraulic

L = latent
max = maximum value
min = minimum value
n = station number indicating supply and exhaust inlets and outlets (see Figure 1)
o = reference state or outlet
p = constant pressure
s = supply side or suction side
t = total

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CHAPTER 27

AIR-HEATING COILS

Coil Construction and Design 27.1
Coil Selection 27.3
Installation Guidelines 27.4
Coil Maintenance 27.5

AIR-HEATING coils are used to heat air under forced convection. The total coil surface may consist of a single coil section or several coil sections assembled into a bank. The coils described in this chapter apply primarily to comfort heating and air conditioning using steam, hot water, refrigerant vapor heat reclaim (including heat pumps), and electricity. The choice between the various methods of heating depends greatly on the cost of the various available energy sources. For instance, in areas where electric power is cheaply available and heating requirements are limited, heat pumps are a very viable option. With available power and higher heat requirements, electric heat is used. If electric power is considerably expensive, steam or hot water generated using gas-fired sources is used in larger buildings and district cooling. In smaller buildings, heat is supplied using gas furnaces, which are covered in Chapters 33 and 34. Water and steam heating are also widely used where process waste heat is available.

1. COIL CONSTRUCTION AND DESIGN

Extended-surface coils consist of a primary and a secondary heat-transfer surface. The primary surface is the external surface of the tubes, generally consisting of rows of round tubes or pipes that may be staggered or parallel (in-line) with respect to the airflow. Flattened tubes or tubes with other nonround internal passageways are sometimes used. The inside of the tube is usually smooth and plain, but some coil designs feature various forms of internal fins or turbulence promoters (either fabricated and then inserted, or extruded) to enhance fluid coil performance. The secondary surface is the fins' external surface, which consists of thin metal plates or a spiral ribbon uniformly spaced or wound along the length of the primary surface. The intimate contact with the primary surface provides good heat transfer. Air-heating fluid and steam coils are generally available with different circuit arrangements and combinations that offer varying numbers of parallel water flow passes in the tube core.

Copper and aluminum are the materials most commonly used for extended-surface coils. Tubing made of steel or various copper alloys is used where corrosive forces might attack the coils from inside or outside. The most common combination for low-pressure applications is aluminum fins on copper tubes. Low-pressure steam coils are usually designed to operate up to 350 kPa (gage). Higher-strength tube materials such as red brass, admiralty brass, or cupronickel assembled by brazed construction are usable up to 186°C water or 1 MPa (gage) saturated steam. Higher operating conditions call for electric welded stainless steel construction, designed to meet Section II and Section VIII requirements of the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*.

Customarily, the coil casing consists of a top and bottom channel (also known as baffles or side sheets), two end supports (also known as end plates or tube sheets), and, on longer coils, intermediate supports (also known as center supports or tube sheets). Designs vary, but most are mounted on ducts or built-up systems. Most often, casing material is spangled zinc-coated (galvanized) steel with a minimum coating designation of G90-U. Some corrosive air conditions may require stainless steel casings or corrosive-resistant coating, such as a baked phenolic applied by the manufacturer to the entire coil surface. Steam coil casings should be designed to accommodate thermal expansion of the tube core during operation (a **floating core** arrangement).

Common core tube diameters vary from 8 up to 25 mm outside diameter (OD) and fin spacings from 1.4 to 6.4 mm. Fluid heating coils have a tube spacing from 20 to 45 mm and tube diameters from 8 to 16 mm OD. Steam coils have tube spacing from 30 to 75 mm and tube diameters from 13 to 25 mm OD. The most common arrangements are one- or two-row steam coils and two- to four-row hot-water coils. Fins should be spaced according to the application requirements, with particular attention given to any severe duty conditions, such as inlet temperatures and contaminants in the airstream.

Tube wall thickness and the required use of alloys other than (standard) copper are determined primarily by the coil's specified maximum allowable working pressure (MAWP) requirements. A secondary consideration is expected coil service life. Fin type, header, and connection construction also play a large part in this determination. All applicable local job site codes and national safety standards should be followed in the design and application of heating coils.

Flow direction can strongly affect heat transfer surface performance. In air-heating coils with only one row of tubes, the air flows at right angles to the heating medium. Such a cross-flow arrangement is common in steam heating coils. The steam temperature in the tubes remains uniform, and the mean temperature difference is the same regardless of the direction of flow relative to the air. The steam supply connection is located either in the center or at the top of the inlet header. The steam condensate outlet (return connection) is always at the lowest point in the return header.

When coils have two or more tube rows in the direction of airflow, such as hot-water coils, the heating medium in the tubes may be circuited in various parallel-flow and counterflow arrangements. Counterflow is the arrangement most preferred to obtain the highest possible mean temperature difference, which determines the heat transfer of the coil. The greater this temperature difference, the greater the coil's heat transfer capacity. In multirow coils circuited for counterflow, water enters the tube row on the leaving air side of the coil.

Steam Coils

Steam coils are generally classified, similarly to boilers, by operating pressure: low (≤100 kPa) or high (>100 kPa). However, various organizations use other pressure classification schemes with differing divisions [e.g., low (≤100 kPa), medium (100 to 690 kPa), or high (>690 kPa). Steam coils can also be categorized by operating limits of the tube materials:

Standard steam	≤1030 kPa	185°C	copper tube
High-pressure steam	≤1625 kPa	204°C	special material [e.g., cupronickel (CuNi)]

Although these operating conditions are allowed by code, long exposures to them will shorten coil tube life. Leaks are less likely when the coil tube core has thicker walls of higher-strength materials.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.4, Air-to-Refrigerant Heat Transfer Equipment.

Table 1 Preferred Operating Limits for Continuous-Duty Steam Coil Materials in Commercial and Institutional Applications

Pressure, kPa	Material	Tube Wall Thickness, mm
≤35	Copper	0.51
35 to 100		0.64
100 to 200		0.89
200 to 345		1.25
345 to 515	Red brass	0.64
515 to 690		0.89
690 to 1035	90/10 CuNi	0.89
1035 to 1380		1.25

Note: Red brass and CuNi may be interchanged, depending on coil manufacturer's specifications.

Operational experience suggests preferred limits for continuous-duty steam coils (tube OD ranging from 16 to 25 mm) in commercial and institutional applications, as shown in Table 1.

Steam coils also can be categorized by type as basic steam, steam-distributing, or face-and-bypass.

Basic steam coils generally have smooth tubes with fins on the air side. The steam supply connection is at one end and the tubes are pitched toward the condensate return, which is usually at the opposite end. For horizontal airflow, the tubes can be either vertical or horizontal. Horizontal tubes should be pitched within the casing toward the condensate return to facilitate condensate removal. Uniform steam distribution to all tubes is accomplished by careful selection of header size, its connection locations, and positioning of inlet connection distributor plates. Orifices also may be used at the core tube entrances in the supply header.

Steam-distributing coils most often incorporate perforated inner tubes that distribute steam evenly along the entire coil. The perforations perform like small steam ejector jets that, when angled in the inner tube, help remove condensate from the outer tube. An alternative design for short coils is an inner tube with no distribution holes, but with an open end. On all coils, supply and return connections can be at the same end or at opposite ends of the coil. For long, low-pressure coils, supply is usually at both ends and the condensate return on one end only.

Face-and-bypass steam coils have short sections of steam coils separated by air bypass openings. Airflow through the coil or bypass section is controlled by coil face-and-bypass dampers linked together. As a freeze protection measure, large installations use face-and-bypass steam coils with vertical tubes.

For proper performance of all types of steam heating coils, air or other noncondensables in the steam supply must be eliminated. Equally important, condensate from the steam must easily drain from inside the coil. Air vents are located at a high point of the piping and at the coil's inlet steam header. Whether airflow is horizontal or vertical, the coil's finned section is pitched toward the condensate return connection end of the coil. Installers must give particular care in the selection and installation of piping, controls, and insulation necessary to protect the coil from freeze-up caused by incomplete condensate drainage.

When entering air is at or below 0°C, the steam supply to the coil should not be modulated, but controlled as full on or full off. Coils located in series in the airstream, with each coil sized and controlled to be full on or completely off (in a specific sequence, depending on the entering air temperature), are not as likely to freeze. Temperature control with face-and-bypass dampers is also common. During part-load conditions, air is bypassed around the steam coil with full steam flow to the coil. In a face-and-bypass arrangement, high-velocity streams of freezing air must not impinge on the coil when the face dampers are partially closed. The section on Overall Requirements in this chapter and the section on Heating Coils in Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* have more details.

Water/Aqueous Glycol Heating Coils

Normal-temperature hot-water heating coils can be categorized as booster coils or standard heating coils. Booster (duct-mounted or reheat) coils are commonly found in variable-air-volume systems. They are one or two rows deep, have minimal water flow, and provide a small air temperature rise. Casings can be either flanged or slip-and-drive construction. Standard heating coils are used in run-around systems, makeup air units, and heating and ventilating systems. All use standard construction materials of copper tube and aluminum fins.

High-temperature water coils may operate with up to 200°C water, with pressures comparable or somewhat higher than the saturated vapor temperature of the water supply. The temperature drop across the coil may be as high as 85 K. To safely accommodate these fluid temperatures and thermal stresses, the coil requires industrial-grade construction that conforms to applicable boiler and safety codes. These requirements should be listed in detail by the specifying engineer, along with the inspection and certification requirements and a compliance check before coil installation and operation.

Proper water coil performance depends on eliminating air and on good water distribution in the coil and its interconnecting piping. Unless properly vented, air may accumulate in the coil circuits, which reduces heat transfer and possibly causes noise and vibration in the pipes. For this reason, water coils should be constructed with self-venting, drainable circuits. The self-venting design is maintained by field-connecting the water supply connection to the bottom and the water return connection to the top of the coil. Ideally, water is supplied at the bottom, flows upward through the coil, and forces any air out the return connection. Complete fluid draining at the supply connection indicates that coils are self draining and without air or water traps. Such a design ensures that the coil is always filled with water, and it should completely drain when it is required to be empty. Most manufacturers provide vent and drain fittings on the supply and return headers of each water coil.

When water does get trapped in the coil core, it is usually caused by a sag in the coil core or by a nondraining circuit design. During freezing periods, even a small amount of water in the coil core can rupture a tube. Also, such a static accumulation of either water or glycol can corrode the tube over an extended period. Large multirow, multicircuited coils may not drain rapidly, even with self-draining circuitry; if they are not installed level, complete self draining will not take place. This problem can be prevented by including intermediate drain headers and installing the coil so that it is pitched toward the connections.

To produce desired ratings without excessive water pressure drop, manufacturers use various circuit arrangements. A single-feed serpentine circuit is commonly used on booster coils with low water flows. With this arrangement, a single feed carrying the entire water flow makes a number of passes across the airstream. The more common circuit arrangement is called a **full row feed** or **standard circuit**. With this design, all the core tubes of a row are fed with an equal amount of water from the supply header. Others, such as quarter, half, and double-row feed circuit arrangements, may be available, depending on the total number of tubes and rows of the coil. Uniform flow in each water circuit is obtained by designing each circuit's length as equal to the other as possible.

Generally, higher velocity provides greater capacity and more even discharge air temperature across the coil face, but with diminishing returns. To prevent erosion, do not exceed 1.8 m/s for copper coils. At higher velocities, only modest gains in capacity can be achieved at increasingly higher pumping power penalties. Above 2.4 m/s, any gain is negligible.

Velocities with fluid flow Reynolds numbers (Re) between 2000 and 10 000 fall into a transition range where heat transfer capacity predictions are less likely to be accurately computed. Below Re = 2000, flow is laminar, where heat transfer prediction is again reliable, but coil capacity is greatly diminished and tube fouling can become a problem. For further insight on the transition flow effect on capacity, refer to Figure 16 of Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute (AHRI) *Standard* 410. Methods of controlling water coils to produce a uniform exit air temperature are discussed in Chapter 47 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

In some cases, the hot water circulated may contain a considerable amount of sand and other foreign matter such as minerals. This matter should be filtered from the water circuit. Additionally, some coil manufacturers offer removable water header boxes (some are plates), or a removable plug at the return bends of each tube, allowing the tubes to be rodded clean. In an area where build-up of scale or other deposits is expected, include a fouling factor when computing heating coil performance. Hot-water coil ratings (AHRI *Standard* 410) include a 44 $(mm^2 \cdot K)/W$ fouling factor. Cupronickel, red brass, admiralty, stainless steel, and other tube alloys can protect against corrosion and erosion, which can be common in hot-water/glycol systems.

Volatile Refrigerant Heat Reclaim Coils

A heat reclaim coil with a volatile refrigerant can function as a condenser either in series or parallel with the primary condenser of a refrigeration system. Heat from condensing or desuperheating vapor warms the airstream. It can be used as a primary source of heat or to assist some other form of heating, such as reheat for humidity control. In the broad sense, a heat reclaim coil functions at half the heat-dissipating capacity of its close-coupled refrigerant system's condenser. Thus, a heat reclaim coil should be (1) piped to be upstream from the condenser and (2) designed with the assumption that some condensate must be removed from the coil. For these reasons, locate the coil outlet at the lowest point of the coil and trap it if this location is lower than the condenser inlet.

Heat reclaim coils are normally circuited for counter-flow of air and refrigerant. However, most supermarket heat reclaim coils are two rows deep and use a cross-flow design. The section on Air-Cooled Condensers in Chapter 39 has additional information on this topic. Because refrigerant heat reclaim involves specialized heating coil design, a refrigerant equipment manufacturer is the best source for information on the topic.

Electric Heating Coils

An electric heating coil consists of a length of resistance wire (commonly nickel/chromium) to which a voltage is applied. The resistance wire may be bare or sheathed in an electrically insulating layer, such as magnesium oxide, and compacted inside a finned steel tube. Sheathed coils are more expensive, have a higher air-side pressure drop, and require more space. A useful comparison for sizing is a heat transfer capacity of 130 kW/m^2 of face area compared to 320 kW/m^2 for bare resistance wire coils. However, the outer surface temperature of sheathed coils is lower, the coils are mechanically stronger, and contact with personnel or housing is not as dangerous. Coils with sheathed heating elements having an extended finned surface are generally preferred (1) for dust-laden atmospheres, (2) where there is a high probability of maintenance personnel contact, or (3) downstream from a dehumidifying coil that might have moisture carryover. Manufacturers can provide further information, including selection recommendations, applications, and maintenance instructions.

2. COIL SELECTION

The following factors should be considered in coil selection:

- Required duty or capacity considering other components
- Temperature of air entering the coil and air temperature rise
- Available heating media's operating and maximum pressure(s) and temperature(s)
- Space and dimensional limitations
- Air volume, speed, distribution, and limitations
- Heating media volume, flow speed, distribution, and limitations
- Permissible flow resistances for both the air and heating media
- Characteristics of individual designs and circuit possibilities
- Individual installation requirements, such as type of control and material compatibility
- Specified and applicable codes and standards regulating the design and installation.

Load requirements are discussed in Chapters 17 and 18 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Much is based on the choice of heating medium, as well as operating temperatures and core tube diameter. Also, proper selection depends on whether the installation is new, being modified, or a replacement. Dimensional fit is usually the primary concern of modified and replacement coils; heating capacity is often unknown.

Air quantity is regulated by factors such as design parameters, codes, space, and size of the components. Resistance through the air circuit influences fan power and speed. This resistance may be limited to allow use of a given size fan motor or to keep operating expenses low, or because of sound level requirements. All of these factors affect coil selection. The air friction loss across the heating coil (summed with other series air pressure drops for system component such as air filters, cooling coils, grilles, and ductwork) determines the static pressure requirements of the complete air system. See Chapter 21 for selecting the fan component.

Permissible resistance through the water or glycol coil circuitry may be dictated by the available pressure from a given size pump and motor. This is usually controlled within limits by careful selection of coil header size and the number of tube circuits. Additionally, the adverse effect of high fluid velocity in contributing to erosion/corrosion of the tube wall is a major factor in selecting tube diameter and the circuit. Heating coil performance depends on the correct choice of original equipment and proper application and installation. For steam coils, proper performance relies first on selecting the correct type of steam coil, and then the proper size and type of steam trap. Properly sized connecting refrigerant lines, risers, and traps are critical to heat reclaim coils.

Heating coil thermal performance is relatively simple to derive. It only involves a dry-bulb temperature and sensible heat, without the complications of latent load and wet-bulb temperature for dehumidifying cooling performance. Even simpler, consult coil manufacturers' catalogs for ratings and selection. Most manufacturers provide computerized coil selection and rating programs on request; some are certified accurate within 5% of an application parameter, representative of a normal application range. Many manufacturers participate in the AHRI Coil Certification Program, which approves application ratings that conform to all AHRI *Standard* 410 requirements, based on qualifying testing to ASHRAE *Standard* 33.

Coil Ratings

Coil ratings are based on uniform face velocity. Nonuniform airflow may be caused by the system, such as air entering at odd angles, or by inadvertent blocking of part of the coil face. To obtain rated performance, the airflow quantity in the field must correspond to the design requirements and the velocity vary no greater than 20% at any point across the coil face.

The industry-accepted method of coil rating is outlined in AHRI *Standard* 410. Test requirements for determining standard coil ratings are specified in ASHRAE *Standard* 33. AHRI application ratings are derived by extending the ASHRAE standard rating test results for other operating conditions, coil sizes, row depths, and

fin count for a particular coil design and arrangement. Steam, water, and glycol heating coils are rated within the following limits (Table 1 of AHRI *Standard* 410), which may be exceeded for special applications.

Air face velocity. 1 to 8 m/s, based on air density of 1.2 kg/m^3

Entering air temperature. Steam coils: –29 to 38°C
Water coils: –18 to 38°C

Steam pressure. 14 to 1723 kPa (gage) at coil steam supply connection (pressure drop through steam control valve must be considered)

Fluid temperatures. Water: 49 to 121°C
Ethylene glycol and propylene glycol: –18 to 93°C

Fluid velocities. Water: 0.1 to 2.4 m/s
Ethylene glycol and propylene glycol: 0.1 to 1.8 m/s

Overall Requirements

Individual installations vary widely, but the following values can be used as a guide. The air face velocity is usually between 2.5 and 5 m/s. Delivered air temperature varies from about 22°C for ventilation only to about 65°C for complete heating. Steam pressure typically varies from 15 to 100 kPa (gage), with 35 kPa (gage) being the most common. A minimum steam pressure of 35 kPa (gage) is recommended for systems with entering air temperatures below freezing. Hot-water (or glycol) temperature for comfort heating is commonly between 80 and 95°C, with water velocities between 1.2 and 1.8 m/s. For high-temperature water, water temperatures can be over 200°C with operating pressures of 100 to 170 kPa over saturated water temperature.

Water quantity is usually based on about 11 K temperature drop through the coil. Air resistance is usually limited to 100 to 150 Pa for commercial buildings and to about 250 Pa for industrial buildings. High-temperature water systems commonly have a water temperature between 150 and 200°C, with up to 80 K drop through the coil.

Steam coils are selected with dry steam velocities not exceeding 30 m/s and with acceptable condensate loading per coil core tube depending on the type of steam coil. Table 2 shows some typical maximum condensate loads.

Steam coil performance is maximized when the supply is dry, saturated steam, and condensate is adequately removed from the coil and continually returned to the boiler.

Although steam quality may not significantly affect the coil's heat transfer, the back-up effect of too rapid a condensate rate, augmented by a wet supply stream, can cause a slug of condensate to travel through the coil and condensate return. This situation can result in noise and possible damage.

Complete mixing of return and outdoor air is essential to proper coil operation. The design of the air mixing damper or ductwork connection section is critical to the proper operation of a system and its air temperature delivery. Systems in which the air passes through a fan before flowing through a coil do not ensure proper air mixing. Dampers at the inlet air face of a steam coil should be the opposed-blade type, which are better than in-line blades for controlling air volume and reducing individual blade-directed cold airstreams when modulating in low-heat mode.

Heat Transfer and Pressure Drops. For air-side heat transfer and pressure drop, the information in Chapter 23 for sensible cooling coils is applicable. For water (or glycol) coils, Chapter 23's information on water-side heat transfer and pressure drop also applies here. For steam coils, the heat transfer coefficient of condensing steam must be calculated (see Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). For estimating the pressure drop of condensing steam, see Chapter 5 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Table 2 Typical Maximum Condensate Loads

Tube Outside Diameter	Maximum Allowable Condensate Load, g/s	
	Basic Coil	Steam Distributing Coil
16 mm	8.6	5.0
25 mm	21.2	12.0

Parametric Effects. The heat transfer performance of a given coil can be changed by varying the airflow rate and/or the temperature of the heating medium, both of which are relatively linear. Understanding the interaction of these parameters is necessary for designing satisfactory coil capacity and control. A review of manufacturers' catalogs and selection programs, many of which are listed in AHRI's *Directory of Certified Product Performance* and *Forced-Circulation Air-Cooling and Air-Heating Coils*, shows the effects of varying these parameters.

3. INSTALLATION GUIDELINES

Steam systems designed to operate at outdoor air temperatures below 0°C should be different from those designed to operate above it. Below 0°C, the steam air-heating system should be designed as a preheat and reheat pair of coils. The preheat coil functions as a nonmodulating basic steam coil, which requires full steam pressure whenever the outdoor temperature is below freezing. The reheat coil, typically a modulated steam-distributing coil, provides the heating required to reach the design air temperature. Above 0°C, the heating coil can be either a basic or steam-distributing type as needed for the duty.

When the leaving air temperature is controlled by modulating steam supply to the coil, steam-distributing tube coils provide the most uniform exit air temperature (see the section on Steam Coils). Correctly designed steam-distributing tube coils can limit the exit air temperature stratification to a maximum of 3 K over the entire length of the coil, even when steam supply is modulated to a fraction of full-load capacity.

Low-pressure steam systems and coils controlled by modulating steam supply should have a vacuum breaker or be drained through a vacuum-return system to ensure proper condensate drainage. It is good practice to install a closed vacuum breaker (where required) connected to the condensate return line through a check valve. This unit breaks the vacuum by equalizing the pressure, yet minimizes the possibility of air bleeding into the system. Steam traps should be located at least 300 mm below the condensate outlet to allow the coil to drain properly. Also, coils supplied with low-pressure steam or controlled by modulating steam supply should not be trapped directly to an overhead return line. Condensate can be lifted to overhead returns only when enough pressure is available to overcome the condensate head and any return line pressure. If overhead returns are necessary, the condensate must be pumped to the higher elevation (see Chapter 11).

Water coils for air heating generally have horizontal tubes to avoid air pockets. Where water or glycol coils may be exposed to a freezing condition, drainability must be considered. If a coil is to be drained and then exposed to below-freezing temperatures, it should first be flushed with a nonfreeze solution.

To minimize the danger of freezing in both steam and water-heating coils, the outdoor air inlet dampers usually close automatically when the fan is stopped (system shutdown). In steam systems with very cold outdoor air conditions (e.g., –30°C or below), it is desirable to fully open the steam valve when the system is shut down. If outdoor air is used for proportioning building makeup air, the outdoor air damper should be an opposed-blade design.

Heating coils are designed to allow for expansion and contraction resulting from the temperature ranges in which they operate. Be careful not to impose strains from the piping to the coil connections,

particularly on high-temperature hot-water applications. Expansion loops, expansion or three-elbow swing joints, or flexible connections usually provide the needed protection (see Chapter 11).

Good practice supports banked coils individually in an angle-iron frame or a similar supporting structure. With this arrangement, the lowest coil is not required to support the mass of the coils stacked above. This design also facilitates removing individual coils in a multiple-coil bank for repair or replacement.

Heat reclaim coils depend on a closely located, readily available source of high-side refrigerant vapor. For example, supermarket rack compressors and the air handler's coil section should be installed close to the store's motor room. Most commonly, the heat reclaim coil section is piped in series with the rack's condenser and sized for 50% heat extraction. Heat reclaim in supermarkets is discussed in Chapter 2 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*; also see Chapter 15 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

In heat pump applications, the heating coil is usually the indoor coil that is used for cooling in the summer. The heat pump system is normally optimized for cooling load and efficiency. Heating performance is a by-product of cooling performance, and any unsatisfied heating requirement is met using electric heating coils. The refrigerant circuiting is also specialized and involves driving the refrigerant in the reverse direction from the cooling mode. Heat pump coils also have an additional check valve bypass to the expansion device for operating in heat pump mode. For additional details about heat pump coil design and operation, see Chapters 9 and 49.

4. COIL MAINTENANCE

Both internal and external surfaces must be clean for coils to deliver their full rated capacity. The tubes generally stay clean in glycol systems and in adequately maintained water systems. Should scale be detected in the piping where untreated water is used, chemical or mechanical cleaning of the internal tube surfaces is required. The need for periodic descaling can be minimized by proper boiler water treatment and deaeration.

Internal coil maintenance consists primarily of preventing scale and corrosion in the coil core tubes and piping of potable-water-heating (including steam) systems. In its simplest form, this involves removing dissolved oxygen, maintaining deionized water, and controlling boiler water pH. Boiler water can be deaerated mechanically. Vacuum deaerating simultaneously removes oxygen and carbon dioxide. The last traces of oxygen can be removed chemically by adding sodium sulfide. For steam coils, 100% dry steam contains 0% air. Good boiler water results in the absence of oxygen and a pH maintained at 10.5. If this is not practicable, a pH of 7 to 9 with a corrosion inhibitor is recommended. Because calcium carbonate is less soluble in water at higher pH, the inhibitor most often used for this purpose is sodium nitrate. Usually, the requirements for chemical treatment increase as the temperature of the coil's return flow drops. With few exceptions, boiler water chemical treatment programs use only proportional feeding, which is the recommended way of maintaining a constant concentration at all times. Periodic batch or slug feeding of water treatment chemicals is not an accurate way to treat boiler water, particularly if the system has a high water makeup rate. Only use chemicals known to be compatible with the coil's tube and connection metal(s). Chemical treatment of boiler water is complicated and has environmental effects. For this reason, it is important to consult a water treatment specialist to establish a proper boiler water treatment program. For further information on boilers, see Chapter 32.

The finned surface of heating coils can sometimes be brushed and cleaned with a vacuum cleaner. Coils are commonly surface-cleaned annually using pressurized hot water containing a mild detergent. Reheat coils that contain their refrigerant charge should never be cleaned with a spray above 65°C. In extreme cases of neglect, especially in restaurants where grease and dirt have accumulated, coil(s) may need to be removed to completely clean off the accumulation with steam, compressed air and water, or hot water containing a suitable detergent. Pressurized cleaning is more thorough if first done from the coil's air leaving side, before cleaning from the coil's air entry side. Often, outdoor makeup air coils have no upstream air filters, so they should be visually checked on a frequent schedule. Overall, coils should be inspected and serviced regularly. Visual observation should not be relied on to judge cleaning requirements for coils greater than three rows deep because airborne dirt tends to pack midway through the depth of the coil.

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CHAPTER 28

UNIT VENTILATORS, UNIT HEATERS, AND MAKEUP AIR UNITS

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1. UNIT VENTILATORS

A **HEATING unit ventilator** is an assembly whose principal functions are to heat, ventilate, and cool a space by introducing outdoor air in quantities up to 100% of its rated capacity. The heating medium may be steam, hot water, gas, or electricity. The essential components of a heating unit ventilator are the fan, motor, heating element, damper, filter, automatic controls, and outlet grille, all of which are encased in a housing.

An **air-conditioning unit ventilator** is similar to a heating unit ventilator; however, in addition to the normal winter function of heating, ventilating, and cooling with outdoor air, it is also equipped to cool and dehumidify during the summer. It is usually arranged and controlled to introduce a fixed quantity of outdoor air for ventilation during cooling in mild weather. The air-conditioning unit ventilator may be provided with a various of combinations of heating and air-conditioning elements. Some of the more common arrangements include

- Combination hot- and chilled-water coil (two-pipe)
- Separate hot- and chilled-water coils (four-pipe)
- Hot-water or steam coil and direct-expansion coil
- Electric heating coil and chilled-water or direct-expansion coil
- Gas-fired furnace with direct-expansion coil

The typical unit ventilator has controls that allow heating, ventilating, and cooling to be varied while the fans operate continuously. In normal operation, the discharge air temperature from a unit is varied in accordance with the room requirements. The heating unit ventilator can provide **ventilation cooling** by bringing in outdoor air whenever the room temperature is above the room set point and outside air is below its set point. Air-conditioning unit ventilators can provide refrigerated cooling when the outdoor air temperature is too high to be used effectively for ventilation cooling.

Unit ventilators are available for floor mounting, ceiling mounting, and recessed applications. They are available with various airflow and capacity ratings, and the fan can be arranged so that air is either blown through or drawn through the unit. With direct-expansion refrigerant cooling, the condensing unit can either be furnished as an integral part of the unit ventilator assembly or be remotely located.

Figure 1A shows a typical heating unit ventilator. The heating coil can be hot water, steam, or electric. Hot-water coils can be provided with face-and-bypass dampers for capacity control, if desired. Valve control of capacity is also available.

Figure 1B shows a typical air-conditioning unit ventilator with a combination hot- and chilled-water coil for use in a two-pipe system. This type of unit is usually provided with face-and-bypass dampers for capacity control.

Figure 1C illustrates a typical air-conditioning unit ventilator with two separate coils, one for heating and the other for cooling with a four-pipe system. The heating coil may be hot water, steam, or electric. The cooling coil can be either a chilled-water coil or a direct-expansion refrigerant coil. Heating and cooling coils are sometimes combined in a single coil by providing separate tube circuits for each function. In such cases, the effect is the same as having two separate coils.

Figure 1D illustrates a typical air-conditioning unit ventilator with a fan section, a gas-fired heating furnace section, and a direct-expansion refrigerant coil section.

Application

Unit ventilators are used primarily in schools, meeting rooms, offices, and other areas where the density of occupancy requires controlled ventilation to meet local codes.

Floor-model unit ventilators are normally installed on an outer wall near the centerline of the room. Ceiling models are mounted against either the outer wall or one of the inside walls. Ceiling models discharge air horizontally. Best results are obtained if the unit can be placed so that the airflow is not interrupted by ceiling beams or surface-mounted lighting fixtures.

Downdraft can be a problem in classrooms with large window areas in cold climates. Air in contact with the cold glass is cooled and flows down into the occupied space. Floor-standing units often include one of the following provisions to prevent downdraft along the windows (Figure 2):

- **Window sill heating** uses finned radiators of moderate capacity installed along the wall under the window area. Heated air rises upward by convection and counteracts the downdraft by tempering it and diverting it upward.
- **Window sill recirculation** is achieved by installing the return air intake along the window sill. Room or return air to the unit includes the window's cold downdrafts, thereby removing them from the occupied area.
- **Window sill discharge** directs a portion of the unit ventilator discharge air into a delivery duct along the sill of the window. The discharge air, delivered vertically at the window sill, is distributed throughout the room, and the upwardly directed air combats downdraft.

Selection

Items to be considered in the application of unit ventilators are

- Unit air capacity
- Percent minimum outdoor air
- Heating and cooling capacity
- Cycle of control
- Location of unit

Mild-weather cooling capacity and number of occupants in the space are the primary considerations in selecting the unit's air capacity. Other factors include state and local requirements, volume of the room, density of occupancy, and use of the room. The number of air changes required for a specific application also depends on window area, orientation, and maximum outdoor temperature at which the unit is expected to prevent overheating.

The preparation of the sections on Unit Ventilators and Unit Heaters is assigned to TC 6.1, Hydronic and Steam Equipment and Systems.

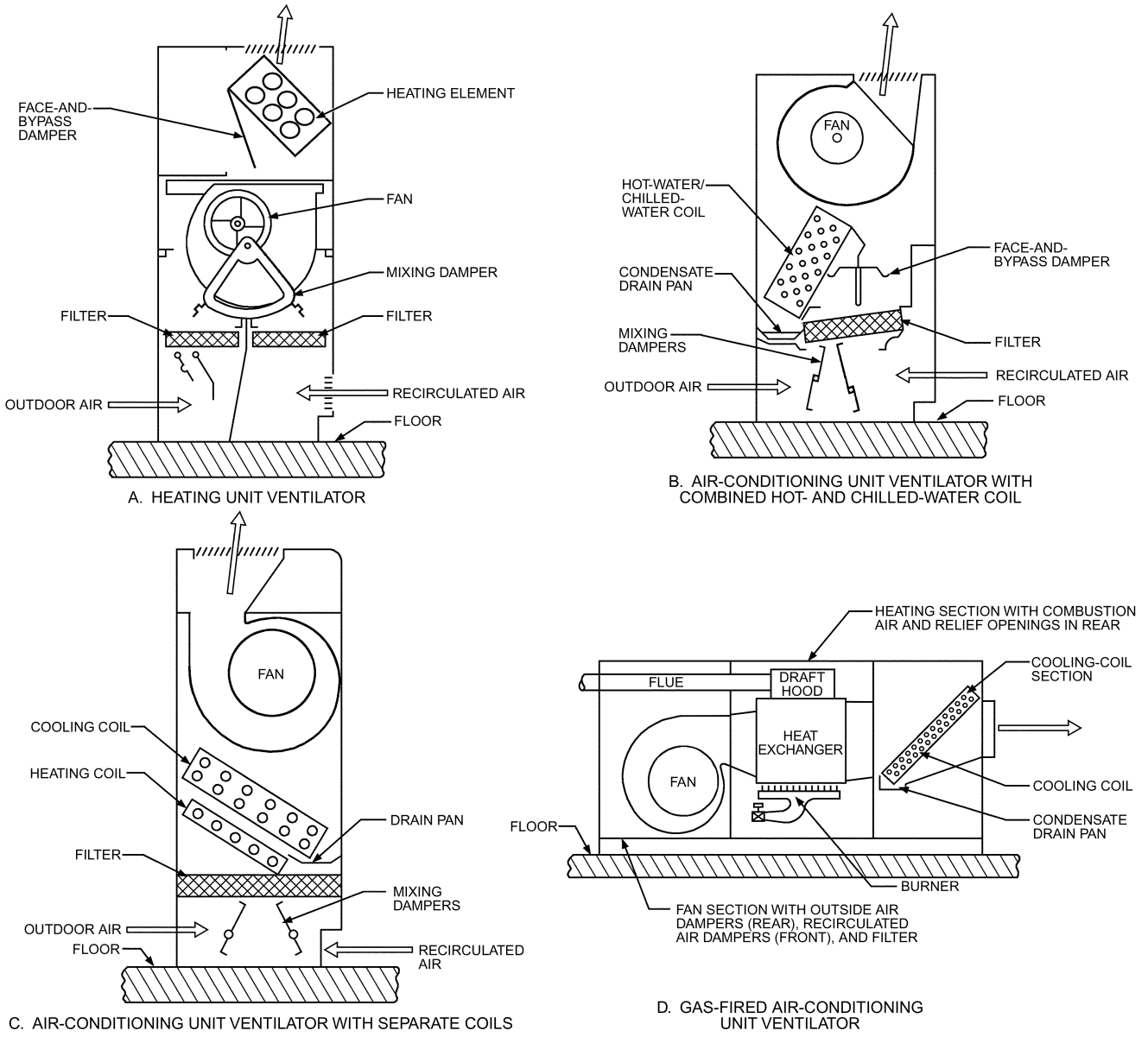

Fig. 1 Typical Unit Ventilators

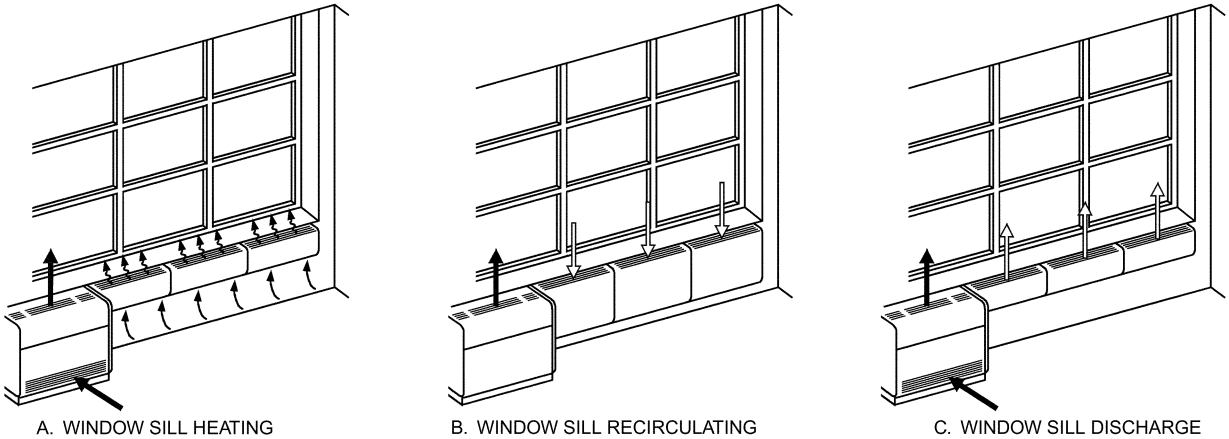

Fig. 2 Methods of Preventing Downdraft along Windows

Rooms oriented to the north (in the northern hemisphere) with small window areas require about 6 air changes per hour (ach). About 9 ach are required in rooms oriented to the south that have large window areas. As many as 12 ach may be required for very large window areas and southern exposures. These airflows are based on preventing overheating at outdoor temperatures up to about 13°C. For satisfactory cooling at outdoor air temperatures up to 15°C, airflow should be increased accordingly.

These airflows apply principally to classrooms. Factories and kitchens may require 30 to 60 ach (or more). Office areas may need 10 to 15 ach.

The minimum amount of outdoor air for ventilation is determined after the total air capacity has been established. It may be governed by local building codes, or it may be calculated to meet the ventilating needs of the particular application. For example, ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 requires 3.8 to 5 L/s of outdoor air per occupant [0.3 to 0.9 L/(s · m^2)] in lecture halls or classrooms, laboratories, and cafeterias, and 2.5 L/s per occupant in conference rooms.

The heating and cooling capacity of a unit to meet the heating requirement can be determined from the manufacturer's data. Heating capacity should always be determined after selecting the unit air capacity for mild-weather cooling.

Capacity. Manufacturers publish the heating and cooling capacities of unit ventilators. Table 1 lists typical nominal capacities.

Heating Capacity Requirements. Because a unit ventilator has a dual function of introducing outdoor air for ventilation and maintaining a specified room condition, the required heating capacity is the sum of the heat required to bring outdoor ventilation air to room temperature and the heat required to offset room losses. The ventilation cooling capacity of a unit ventilator is determined by the air volume delivered by the unit and the temperature difference between the unit discharge and the room temperature.

Example. A room has a heat loss of 7.0 kW at a winter outdoor design condition of –18°C and an indoor design of 21°C, with 20% outdoor air. Minimum air discharge temperature from the unit is 15°C. To obtain the specified number of air changes, a 600 L/s unit ventilator is required. Determine the ventilation heat requirement, the total heating requirement, and the ventilation cooling capacity of this unit with outdoor air temperature below 15°C.

Solution:

Ventilation heat requirement:

$$q_v = \rho c_p Q(t_i - t_o)$$

where

q_v = heat required to heat ventilating air, W
ρ = density of air at standard conditions = 1.2 kg/m^3
c_p = air specific heat = 1.0 kJ/(kg · K)
Q = ventilating airflow, L/s
t_i = required room air temperature, °C
t_o = outdoor air temperature, °C

$$q_v = 1.2 \times 1.0 \times 600 \times (20/100)[21 - (-18)] = 5600 \text{ W}$$

Total heating requirement:

$$q_t = q_v + q_s$$

where

q_t = total heat requirement, W
q_s = heat required to make up heat losses, W

$$q_t = 5.6 + 7.0 = 12.6 \text{ W}$$

Ventilation cooling capacity:

$$q_c = \rho c_p Q(t_i - t_f)$$

where

q_c = ventilation cooling capacity of unit, W
t_f = unit discharge air temperature, °C

Table 1 Typical Unit Ventilator Capacities

Airflow, L/s	Heating Unit Ventilator Total Heating Capacity, kW	A/C Unit Ventilator Total Cooling Capacity, kW
240	10.7	5.6
360	15.6	8.4
480	20.4	11.2
600	25.3	14.0
720	30.2	16.8

$$q_c = 1.2 \times 1.0 \times 600(21 - 15) = 4320 \text{ W}$$

Control

Many cycles of control are available. The main difference in the various cycles is the amount of outdoor air delivered to the room. Usually, a room thermostat simultaneously controls both a valve and either damper or step controller, to regulate the heat supply, and an outdoor and return air damper. A thermostat in the airstream prevents discharge of air below the desired minimum temperature. Unit ventilator controls provide the proper sequence for the following stages:

- **Warm-up.** All control cycles allow rapid warm-up by having the units generate full heat with the outdoor damper closed. Thus 100% of the room air is recirculated and heated until the room temperature approaches the desired level.
- **Heating and ventilating.** As the room temperature rises into the thermostat's operating range, the outdoor air damper partially or completely opens to provide ventilation, depending on the cycle used. Auxiliary heating equipment is shut off. As the room temperature continues to rise, the unit ventilator heat supply is throttled.
- **Cooling and ventilating.** When the room temperature rises above the desired level, the room thermostat throttles the heat supply so that cool air flows into the room. The thermostat gradually shuts off the heat and then opens the outdoor air damper. The airstream thermostat frequently takes control during this stage to keep the discharge temperature from falling below a set level.

There are three cycles of control commonly used for unit ventilators:

- **Cycle I.** 100% outdoor air is admitted at all times, except during warm-up.
- **Cycle II.** A minimum amount of outdoor air (normally 20 to 50%) is admitted during the heating and ventilating stage. This percentage is gradually increased to 100%, if needed, during the ventilation cooling stage.
- **Cycle III.** Except during warm-up, a variable amount of outdoor air is admitted, as needed, to maintain a fixed temperature of air entering the heating element. The amount of air admitted is controlled by the airstream thermostat set low enough (often at 13 °C) to provide cooling when needed.

Air-conditioning unit ventilators can include any of the three cycles in addition to the mechanical cooling stage, where a fixed amount of outdoor air is introduced. The cooling capacity is controlled by the room thermostat.

For maximum heating economy, the building temperature is reduced at night and during weekends and vacations. Several arrangements are used to accomplish this. One arrangement takes advantage of the natural convective capacity of the unit when the fans are off. This capacity is supplemented by cycling the fan with the outdoor damper closed as required to maintain the desired room temperature.

2. UNIT HEATERS

A unit heater is an assembly of elements with the main function of heating a space. The essential elements are a fan and motor, a heating element, and an enclosure. Filters, dampers, directional outlets, duct collars, combustion chambers, and flues may also be included. Some types of unit heaters are shown in Figure 3.

Unit heaters can usually be classified in one or more of the following categories:

- **Heating medium.** Media include (1) steam, (2) hot water, (3) gas indirect-fired, (4) oil indirect-fired, and (5) electric heating.
- **Type of fan.** Three types of fans can be considered: (1) propeller, (2) centrifugal, and (3) remote air mover. Propeller fan units may be arranged to blow air horizontally (horizontal blow) or vertically (downblow). Units with centrifugal fans may be small cabinet units or large industrial units. Units with remote air movers are known as duct unit heaters.
- **Arrangement of elements.** Two types of units can be considered: (1) draw-through, in which the fan draws air through the unit; and (2) blow-through, in which the fan blows air through the heating element. Indirect-fired unit heaters are always blow-through units.

Application

Unit heaters have the following principal characteristics:

- Relatively large heating capacities in compact casings
- Ability to project heated air in a controlled manner over a considerable distance
- Relatively low installed cost per unit of heat output
- Application where an elevated sound level is permissible

They are, therefore, usually placed in applications where the heating capacity requirements, physical volume of the heated space, or both, are too large to be handled adequately or economically by other means. By eliminating extensive duct installations, the space is freed for other use.

Unit heaters are mostly used for heating commercial and industrial structures such as garages, factories, warehouses, showrooms, stores, and laboratories, as well as corridors, lobbies, vestibules, and similar auxiliary spaces in all types of buildings. Unit heaters may often be used to advantage in specialized applications requiring spot or intermittent heating, such as at outer doors in industrial plants or in corridors and vestibules. Cabinet unit heaters may be used where heated air must be filtered.

Unit heaters may be applied to a number of industrial processes (e.g., drying and curing) that use heated air in rapid circulation with uniform distribution. They may be used for moisture absorption applications, such as removing fog in dye houses, or to prevent condensation on ceilings or other cold surfaces of buildings where process moisture is released. When such conditions are severe, unit ventilators or makeup air units may be required.

Selection

The following factors should be considered when selecting a unit heater:

- Heating medium to be used
- Type of unit
- Location of unit for proper heat distribution
- Permissible sound level
- Rating of the unit
- Need for filtration

Heating Medium. The proper heating medium is usually determined by economics and requires examining initial cost, operating cost, and conditions of use.

Steam or **hot-water unit heaters** are relatively inexpensive but require a boiler and piping system. The unit cost of such a system generally decreases as the number of units increases. Therefore, steam or hot-water heating is most frequently used (1) in new installations involving a relatively large number of units, and (2) in existing systems that have sufficient capacity to handle the additional load. High-pressure steam or high-temperature hot-water units are normally used only in very large installations or when a high-temperature medium is required for process work. Low-pressure steam and conventional hot-water units are usually selected for smaller installations and for those concerned primarily with comfort heating.

Gas and **oil indirect-fired unit heaters** are frequently preferred in small installations where the number of units does not justify the expense and space requirements of a new boiler system or where individual metering of the fuel supply is required, as in a shopping center. Gas indirect-fired units usually have either horizontal propeller fans or industrial centrifugal fans. Oil indirect-fired units largely have industrial centrifugal fans. Some codes limit the use of indirect-fired unit heaters in some applications. Indirect-fired oil and gas units are of blow-through design to mitigate the possibility of combustion products entering the occupied space.

Electric unit heaters are used when the cost of available electric power is lower than that of alternative fuel sources and for isolated locations, intermittent use, supplementary heating, or temporary service. Typical applications are ticket booths, security offices, factory offices, locker rooms, and other isolated rooms scattered over large areas. Electric units are particularly useful in isolated and untended pumping stations or pits, where they may be thermostatically controlled to prevent freezing.

Type of Unit. Propeller fan units are generally used in nonducted applications where the heating capacity and distribution requirements can best be met by units of moderate output and where heated air does not need to be filtered. Horizontal-blow units are usually installed in buildings with low to moderate ceiling heights. Downblow units are used in spaces with high ceilings and where floor and wall space limitations dictate that heating equipment be kept out of the way. Downblow units may have an adjustable diffuser to vary the discharge pattern from a high-velocity vertical jet (to achieve the maximum distance of downward throw) to a horizontal discharge of lower velocity (to prevent excessive air motion in the zone of occupancy). Revolving diffusers are also available.

Cabinet unit heaters are used when a more attractive appearance is desired. They are suitable for free-air delivery or low static pressure duct applications. They may be equipped with filters, and they can be arranged to discharge either horizontally or vertically up or down.

Industrial centrifugal fan units are applied where heating capacities and space volumes are large or where filtration of the heated air or operation against static resistance is required. Downblow or horizontal-blow units may be used, depending on the requirements.

Duct unit heaters are used where the air handler is remote from the heater. These heaters sometimes provide an economical means of adding heating to existing cooling or ventilating systems with ductwork. They require flow and temperature limit controls.

Location for Proper Heat Distribution. Units must be selected, located, and arranged to provide complete heat coverage while maintaining acceptable air motion and temperature at an acceptable sound level in the working or occupied zone. Proper application depends on size, number, and type of units; direction of airflow and type of directional outlet used; mounting height; outlet velocity and temperature; and air volumetric flow. Many of these factors are interrelated.

The mounting height may be governed by space limitations or by the presence of equipment such as display cases or machinery. The higher a downblow heater is mounted, the lower the temperature of air leaving the heater must be to force the heated air into the occupied zone. Also, the distance that air leaving the heater travels

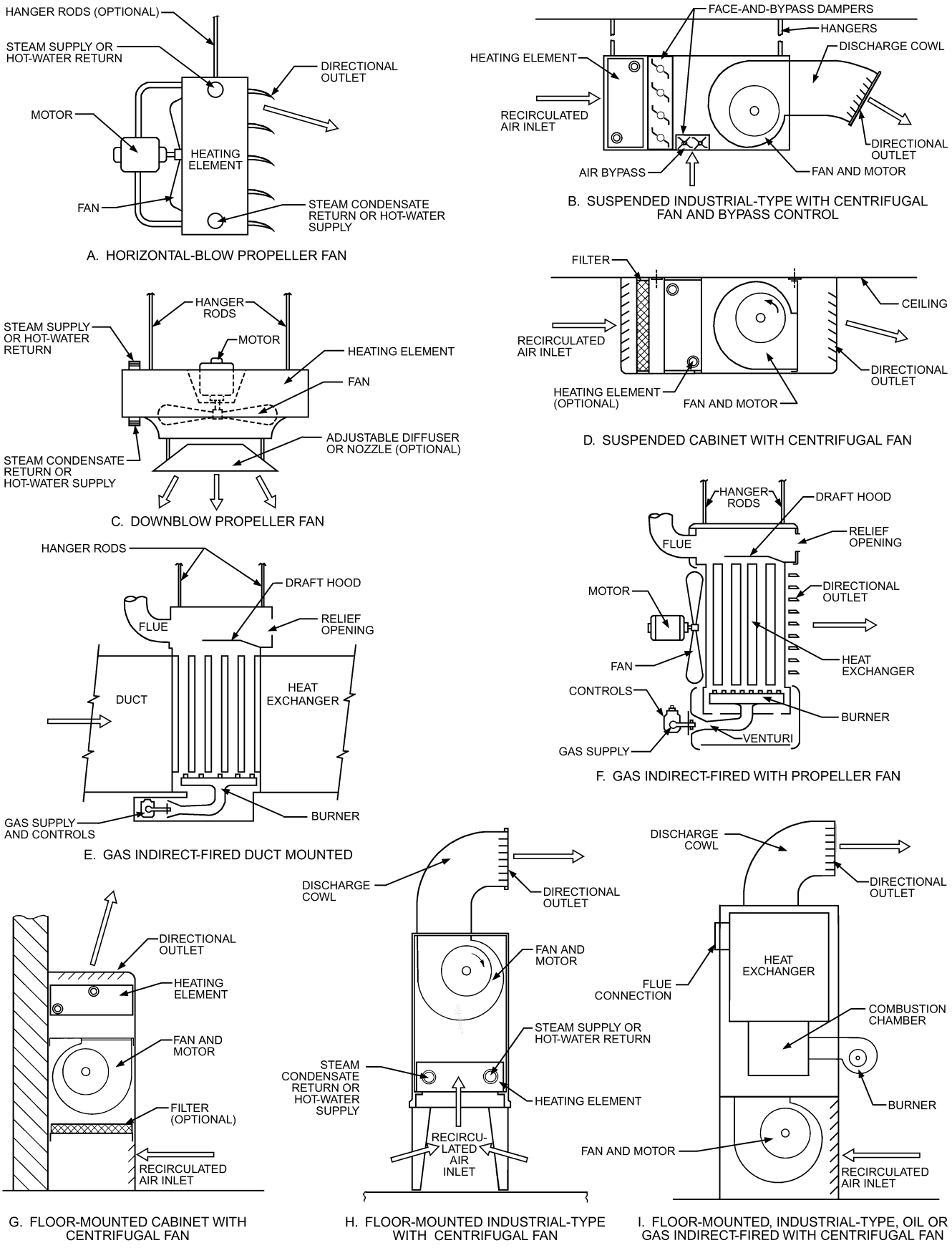

Fig. 3 Typical Unit Heaters

depends largely on the air temperature and initial velocity. A high discharge temperature reduces the area of effective heat coverage because of its buoyancy. High-temperature air is less dense than the cooler air of the space being heated.

Unit heaters for high-pressure steam or high-temperature hot water should be designed to produce approximately the same leaving air temperature as would be obtained from a lower temperature heating medium.

To obtain the desired air distribution and heat diffusion, unit heaters are commonly equipped with directional outlets, adjustable louvers, or fixed or revolving diffusers. For a given unit with a given discharge temperature and outlet velocity, the mounting height and heat coverage can vary widely with the type of directional outlet, adjustable louver, or diffuser. High-volume, low-speed fans in high-ceilinged areas are often used to augment air distribution and reduce temperature stratification.

Other factors that may substantially reduce heat coverage include obstructions (such as columns, beams, or partitions) or machinery in either the discharge airstream or approach area to the unit. Strong drafts or other air currents also reduce coverage. Exposures such as large glass areas or outer doors, especially on the windward side of the building, require special attention; arrange units so that they blanket the exposures with a curtain of heated air and intercept the cold drafts.

For area heating, place horizontal-blow unit heaters in exterior zones such that they blow either along the exposure or toward it at a slight angle. When possible, arrange multiple units so that the discharge airstreams support each other and create a general circulatory motion in the space. Interior zones under exposed roofs or skylights should be completely blanketed. Arrange downblow units so that the heated areas from adjacent units overlap slightly to provide complete coverage.

For spot heating of individual spaces in larger unheated areas, single unit heaters may be used, but allowance must be made for the inflow of unheated air from adjacent spaces and the consequent reduction in heat coverage. Such spaces should be isolated by partitions or enclosures, if possible.

Horizontal unit heaters should have discharge outlets located well above head level. Both horizontal and vertical units should be placed so that the heated airstream is delivered to the occupied zone at acceptable temperature and velocity. Outlet air temperature of free-air delivery unit heaters used for comfort heating should be 27 to 33 K higher than the design room temperature. When possible, locate units so that they discharge into open spaces, such as aisles, and not directly on the occupants. For further information on air distribution, see Chapter 20 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Manufacturers' catalogs usually include suggestions for the best arrangements of various unit heaters, recommended mounting heights, heat coverage for various outlet velocities, final temperatures, directional outlets, and sound level ratings.

Sound Level in Occupied Spaces. Sound pressure levels in workplaces should be limited to values listed in Table 1 in Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*. Although the noise level is generated by all equipment within hearing distance, unit heaters may contribute a significant portion of noise level. Both noise and air velocity in the occupied zone generally increase with increased outlet velocities. An analysis of both the diverse sound sources and the locations of personnel stations establishes the limit to which the unit heaters must be held.

Ratings of Unit Heaters.

Steam or Hot Water. Heating capacity must be determined at a standard condition. Variations in entering steam or water temperature, entering air temperature, and steam or water flow affect capacity. Typical standard conditions for rating steam unit heaters are dry saturated steam at 14 kPa (gage) pressure at the heater coil, air at 15.6°C (101.3 kPa barometric pressure) entering the heater, and the heater operating free of external resistance to airflow. Standard conditions for rating hot-water unit heaters are entering water at 93.3°C, water temperature drop of 11.1 K, entering air at 15.6°C and 101.3 kPa barometric pressure, and the heater operating free of external resistance to airflow.

Gas-Fired. Gas-fired unit heaters are rated in terms of both input and output, in accordance with the approval requirements of the American Gas Association.

Oil-Fired. Ratings of oil-fired unit heaters are based on heat delivered at the heater outlet.

Electric. Electric unit heaters are rated based on the energy input to the heating element.

Effect of Airflow Resistance on Capacity. Unit heaters are customarily rated at free-air delivery. Airflow and heating capacity decrease if outdoor air intakes, air filters, or ducts on the inlet or discharge are used. The capacity reduction caused by this added resistance depends on the characteristics of the heater and on the type, design, and speed of the fans. As a result, no specific capacity reduction can be assigned for all heaters at a given added resistance. The manufacturer should have information on the heat output to be expected at other than free-air delivery.

Effect of Inlet Temperature. Changes in entering air temperature influence the total heating capacity in most unit heaters and the final temperature in all units. Because many unit heaters are located some distance from the occupied zone, possible differences between the temperature of the air actually entering the unit and that of air being maintained in the heated area should be considered, particularly with downblow unit heaters.

Higher-velocity units and units with lower vertical discharge air temperature maintain lower temperature gradients than units with higher discharge temperatures. Valve- or bypass-controlled units with continuous fan operation maintain lower temperature gradients than units with intermittent fan operation. Directional control of the discharged air from a unit heater can also be important in distributing heat satisfactorily and in reducing floor-to-ceiling temperature gradients.

Filters. Air from propeller unit heaters cannot be filtered because the heaters are designed to operate with heater friction loss only. If dust in the building must be filtered, centrifugal fan units or cabinet units should be used. Chapter 29 has further information on air cleaners for particulate contaminants.

Control

The controls for a steam or hot water unit heater can provide either (1) on/off operation of the unit fan, or (2) continuous fan operation with modulation of heat output. For on/off operation, a room thermostat is used to start and stop the fan motor or group of fan motors. A limit thermostat, often strapped to the supply or return pipe, prevents fan operation in the event that heat is not being supplied to the unit. An auxiliary switch that energizes the fan only when power is applied to open the motorized supply valve may also be used to prevent undesirable cool air from being discharged by the unit.

Continuous fan operation eliminates both the intermittent blasts of hot air resulting from on/off operation and the stratification of temperature from floor to ceiling that often occurs during off periods. In this arrangement, a proportional room thermostat controls a valve modulating the heat supply to the coil or a bypass around the heating element. A limit thermostat or auxiliary switch stops the fan when heat is no longer available.

One type of control used with downblow unit heaters is designed to automatically return the warm air, which would normally stratify at the higher level, down to the zone of occupancy. Two thermostats

and an auxiliary switch are required. The lower thermostat is placed in the zone of occupancy and is used to control a two-position supply valve to the heater. An auxiliary switch is used to stop the fan when the supply valve is closed. The higher thermostat is placed near the unit heater at the ceiling or roof level where the warm air tends to stratify. The lower thermostat automatically closes the steam valve when its setting is satisfied, but the higher thermostat overrides the auxiliary switch so that the fan continues to run until the temperature at the higher level falls below a point sufficiently high to produce a heating effect.

Indirect-fired and electric units are usually controlled by intermittent operation of the heat source under control of the room thermostat, with a separate fan switch to run the fan when heat is being supplied. For more information on automatic control, refer to Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Unit heaters can be used to circulate air in summer. In such cases, the heat is shut off and the thermostat has a bypass switch, which allows the fan to run independently of the controls.

Piping Connections

Piping connections for steam unit heaters are similar to those for other types of fan blast heaters. Unit heater piping must conform strictly to the system requirements, while allowing the heaters to function as intended. Basic piping principles for steam systems are discussed in Chapter 11.

Steam unit heaters condense steam rapidly, especially during warm-up periods. The return piping must be planned to keep the heating coil free of condensate during periods of maximum heat output, and the steam piping must be able to carry a full supply of steam to the unit to take the place of condensed steam. Adequate pipe size is especially important when a unit heater fan is operated under on/off control because the condensate rate fluctuates rapidly.

Recommended piping connections for unit heaters are shown in Figure 4. In steam systems, the branch from the supply main to the heater must pitch toward the main and be connected to its top to prevent condensate in the main from draining through the heater, where it might reduce capacity and cause noise.

The return piping from steam unit heaters should provide a minimum drop of 250 mm below the heater, so that the water pressure required to overcome resistances of check valves, traps, and strainers does not cause condensate to remain in the heater.

Dirt pockets at the outlet of unit heaters and strainers with 1.6 mm perforations to prevent rapid plugging are essential to trap dirt and scale that might affect the operation of check valves and traps. Always install strainers in the steam supply line if the heater has steam-distributing coils or is valve controlled.

An adequate air vent is required for low-pressure closed gravity systems. The vertical pipe connection to the air vent should be at least 20 mm DN to allow water to separate from the air passing to the vent. If thermostatic instead of float-and-thermostatic traps are used in vacuum systems, a cooling leg must be installed ahead of the trap.

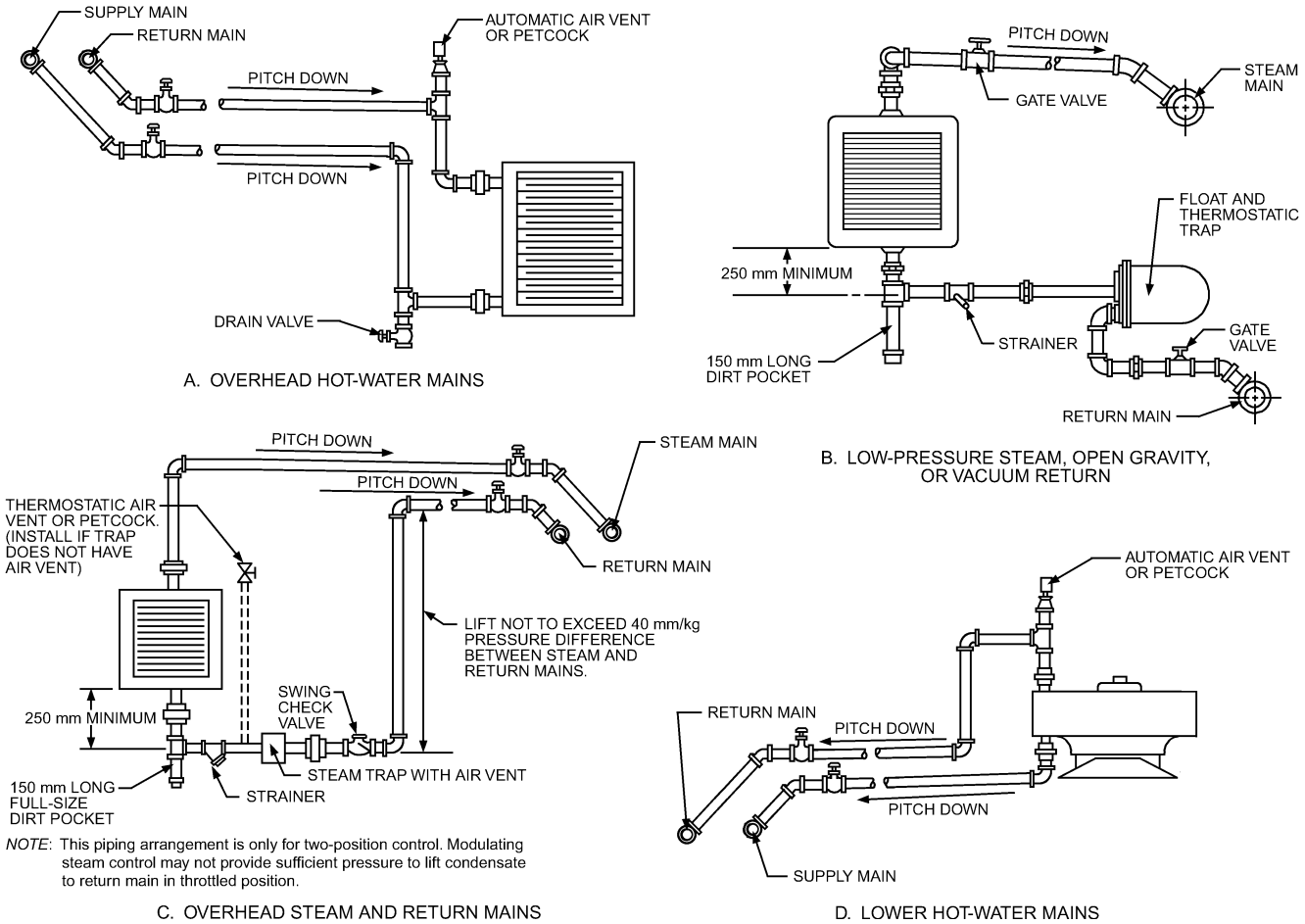

Fig. 4 Hot Water and Steam Connections for Unit Heaters

In high-pressure systems, it is customary to continuously vent the air through a petcock (as shown in Figure 4C), unless the steam trap has a provision for venting air. Most high-pressure return mains terminate in flash tanks that are vented to the atmosphere. When possible, use pressure-reducing valves to allow heater operation at low pressure. Traps must be suitable for the operating pressure encountered.

When piping is connected to hot-water unit heaters, it must be pitched to allow air to vent to the atmosphere at the high point in the piping. An air vent at the heater is used to facilitate air removal or to vent the top of the heater. The system must be designed for complete drainage, including placing nipple and cap drains on drain cocks when units are located below mains.

Maintenance

Regular inspection, based on a schedule determined by the amount of dirt in the atmosphere, assures maximum operating economy and heating capacity. During design, ensure sufficient space for maintenance access to each component. Clean heating elements when necessary, by brushing or blowing with high-pressure air or by using a steam spray. A portable sheet metal enclosure may be used to partially enclose smaller heaters for cleaning in place with air or steam jets. In some installations, however, it may be necessary to remove the heating element and wash it with a mild alkaline solution, followed by a thorough rinsing with water. Propeller units do not have filters and are, therefore, more susceptible to dust build-up on the coils.

Dirt on fan blades reduces capacity and may unbalance the blades, which causes noise and bearing damage. Fan blades should be inspected and cleaned when necessary. Vibration and noise may also be caused by improper fan position or loose set screws. Place a fan guard on downblow unit heaters that have no diffuser or other device to catch the fan blade if it comes loose and falls from the unit.

The amount of attention required by the various motors used with unit heaters varies greatly. Instructions for lubrication, in particular, must be followed carefully for trouble-free operation: excess lubrication, for example, may damage the motor, and an improper lubricant may cause the bearings to fail. Get instructions for care of the motor on any unit heater from the manufacturer and keep them at the unit.

Fan bearings and drives must be lubricated and maintained according to the instructions specified by the manufacturer. If the unit is direct connected, inspect the couplings periodically for wear and alignment. V-belt drives should have all belts replaced with a matched set if one belt shows wear.

Periodic inspections of traps, inspections of check and air valves, and the replacement of worn fans are other important maintenance functions. Strainers should be cleaned regularly. Filters, if included, must be cleaned or replaced when dirty.

3. MAKEUP AIR UNITS

Description and Applications

Makeup air units are designed to condition ventilation air introduced into a space or to replace air exhausted from a building, in compliance with ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 as applicable. The air exhausted may be from a process or general area exhaust, through either powered exhaust fans or gravity ventilators. The units may be used to prevent negative pressure within buildings or to reduce airborne contaminants in a space.

If temperature and/or humidity in the structure are controlled, the makeup air system must have the capacity to condition the replacement air. In most cases, makeup air units must be used to supply this conditioned makeup air. The units may heat, cool, humidify, dehumidify, and/or filter incoming air. They may be used to replace air in the conditioned space or to supplement or accomplish all or part of the airflow needed to satisfy the heating, ventilating, or cooling airflow requirements.

Makeup air can enter at a fixed flow rate or as a variable volume of outdoor air. It can be used to accomplish building pressurization or contamination reduction, and may be controlled in a manner that responds directly to exhaust flow. When compatible with the characteristics and class of the air being exhausted, makeup air units should also be connected to process exhaust with air-to-air heat recovery units, thermal wheels, heat pipes, or runaround coils (recovery loop exchangers) tested (when applicable) under ANSI/ASHRAE *Standard* 84.

Buildings under negative pressure because of inadequate makeup air may have the following symptoms:

- Gravity stacks from unit heaters and processes back-vent.
- Exhaust systems do not perform at rated volume.
- The perimeter of the building is cold in winter because of high infiltration.
- Severe drafts occur at exterior doors.
- Exterior doors are hard to open or close completely.
- Heating systems cannot maintain comfortable conditions throughout the building because the central core area becomes overheated.
- Excessive condensation occurs.

Other Applications.

Spot Cooling. High-velocity air jets in the unit may be directed to working positions. During cold weather, supply air must be tempered or reduced in velocity to avoid overcooling workers.

Door Heating. Localized air supply at swinging doors or overhead doors, such as for loading docks, can be provided by makeup air units. Heaters may blanket door openings with tempered air. The temperature may be reset from the outdoor temperature or with dual-temperature air (low when the door is closed and high when the door is open during cold weather). Heating may be arranged to serve a single door or multiple doors by an air distribution system. Door heating systems may also be arranged to minimize entry of insects during warm weather. Air curtain units for door openings should be tested and comply with ANSI/AMCA *Standard* 220-21, section C408.2.3.

Selection

Makeup air systems used for ventilation may be (1) sized to balance air exhaust volumes or (2) sized in excess of the exhaust volume to dilute contaminants. In applications where contaminant levels vary, variable-flow units should be considered so that the supply air varies for contaminant control and the exhaust volume varies to track supply volume. In critical spaces, the exhaust volume may be based on requirements to control pressure in the space.

Location. Makeup air units are defined by their location or the use of a key component. Examples are rooftop makeup air units, truss- or floor-mounted units, and sidewall units. Some manufacturers differentiate their units by heating mode, such as steam or direct gas-fired makeup air units.

Rooftop units are commonly used for large single-story industrial buildings to simplify air distribution. Access (via roof walks) is more convenient than access to equipment mounted in the truss; truss units are only accessible by installing a catwalk adjacent to the air units. Disadvantages of rooftop units are (1) they increase foot traffic on the roof, thus reducing its life and increasing the likelihood of leaks; (2) inclement weather reduces equipment accessibility; and (3) units are exposed to weather.

Makeup air units can also be placed around the perimeter of a building with air ducted through the sidewall. This approach limits future building expansion, and the effectiveness of ventilating internal spaces decreases as the building gets larger. However, access to

the units is good, and minimum support is required because the units are mounted on the ground.

Use caution in selecting the location of the makeup air unit and/or its associated combustion air source, to avoid introducing combustible vapors into the unit. Consult state and local fire codes for specific guidance.

Heating and Cooling Media.

Heating. Makeup air units are often identified by the heating or cooling medium they use. Heaters in makeup air systems may be direct gas-fired burners, electric resistance heating coils, indirect gas-fired heaters, steam coils, or hot-water heating coils. (Chapter 27 covers the design and application of heating coils.) Air distribution systems are often required to direct heat to spaces requiring it.

Natural gas can be used to supply an indirect-fired burner, as for a large furnace. (Chapter 33 has more information, including detailed heater descriptions.) In a **non-recirculating** direct-fired heater, levels of combustion products generated by the heater are very low (CO < 5.0 mg/kg, NO_2 < 0.5 mg/kg, and CO_2 < 4000 mg/kg) and are released directly into the airstream being heated. All air to a non-recirculating makeup air heater must be ducted directly from outdoor source. Non-recirculating direct gas-fired industrial air heaters are typically certified to comply with ANSI *Standard* Z83.4b/CSA3.7b-2017. In a **recirculating** makeup air heater, ventilation air to the heater must be ducted directly from an outdoor source to limit the concentration of combustion products in the conditioned space to a level below 25 mg/kg for CO, 3 mg/kg for NO_2, and 5000 mg/kg for CO_2. Recirculating direct gas-fired industrial air heaters are typically certified to comply with ANSI *Standard* Z83.18-2017. Installing carbon monoxide detectors to protect building occupants in the event of a heater malfunction is good engineering practice, and may be required by local codes.

Hydronic heating sections in spaces requiring a fully isolated source (100%) of outdoor air must be protected from freezing in cold climates. Low-temperature protection includes two-position control of steam coils; careful selection of the water coil heating surface and control valves; careful control of water supply temperature; and use of an antifreeze additive.

Cooling. Mechanical refrigeration with direct-expansion or chilled-water cooling coils, direct or indirect evaporative cooling sections, or well water coils may be used. Air distribution systems are often required to direct cooling to specific spaces that experience or create heat gain.

Because industrial facilities often have high sensible heat loads, evaporative cooling can be particularly effective. An evaporative cooler helps clean the air, as well. A portion of the spray water must be bled off to keep the water acceptably clean and to maintain a low solids concentration. Chapter 41 of this volume and Chapter 53 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* cover evaporative cooling in more detail.

Chapter 23 provides information on air-cooling coils. If direct-expansion coils are used in conjunction with direct-fired gas coils, the cooling coils' headers must be isolated from the airstream and directly vented outdoors.

Filters. High-efficiency filters (approximately MERV 16 for near-HEPA performance) are not normally used in a makeup air unit because of their relatively high cost. HVAC prefilters are generally in the MERV 6 to 13 range, depending on particulate removal needs. Designers should ensure that all filters are easy to change or clean. Appropriate washing equipment should be located near all washable filters. Throwaway filters should be sized for easy removal and disposal. Chapters 29 and 30 have more information on air filters and cleaners.

Fans. Follow AMCA *Standard* 205-19 for fan selection. This standard addresses fans with a minimum impeller diameter of 125 mm, operating with a shaft power of at least 750 W, and with a total efficiency calculated according to one of the following fan test standards:

- ANSI/AMCA *Standard* 210 (ANSI/ASHRAE *Standard* 51)
- ANSI/AMCA *Standard* 230
- AMCA *Standard* 260
- ISO *Standard* 5801

ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1-2020 requires a fan and fan array efficiency index (FEI) of 1.00 or higher and fans and fan arrays of variable volume to have and FEI of 0.95 or higher, and that the fan should be sized and selected within 15% of its peak total efficiency (FEI 71 calculated under AMCA *Standard* 205 Annex C and ICC [2021]).

Fans should have variable-speed drives for possible energy savings or for use in variable-airflow systems.

Control

Controls for a makeup air unit fall into the following categories: (1) local temperature controls, (2) airflow controls, (3) plant-wide controls for proper equipment operation and efficient performance, (4) safety controls for burner gas, and (5) building smoke control systems. For control system information, refer to Chapters 42, 43, and 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Safety controls for gas-fired units include components to properly light the burner and to provide a safeguard against flame failure. The heater and all attached inlet ducting must be purged with at least four air changes before initiating an ignition sequence and before reignition after a malfunction. A flame monitor and control system must be used to automatically shut off gas to the burner upon burner ignition or flame failure. Critical malfunctions include flame failure, supply fan failure, combustion air depletion, power failure, control signal failure, excessive or inadequate inlet gas supply pressure, excess air temperature, and gas leaks in motorized valves or inlet gas supply piping.

Makeup air units should be interlocked with exhaust units to avoid overpressurization, and should include shutoff dampers with limit switches for when not in use. Damper leakage rates should be within limits set in ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1. These units should also be interlocked to the building's fire alarm system to shut down in the case of a fire, where required by applicable codes.

Consider using automatic safety shutoff valves on interconnecting piping systems where there are risks of overtemperature, overpressure, or gas leaks.

Applicable Codes and Standards

A gas-fired makeup air unit must be designed and built in accordance with NFPA *Standard* 54 and the requirements of the owner's insurance underwriter. Local codes must also be observed when using direct-fired gas makeup air units because some jurisdictions prohibit or restrict their use and may also require exhaust fans to be used while the unit is in operation.

The following standard and codes and the sources in the References may also apply, depending on the application.

AHRI. 2018. Performance rating of air-to-air exchangers for energy recovery ventilation equipment. ANSI/AHRI *Standard* 1060. Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute, Arlington, VA.

ICC. 2021. *International mechanical code*® (IMC®). International Code Council, Falls Church, VA.

ICC. 2015. *International fuel gas code*® (IFGC®). International Code Council, Falls Church, VA.

NFPA 2021 National Fire Protection Association. National Fire Code. Quincy, MA.

Commissioning

Commissioning of makeup air systems is similar to that of other air-handling systems, requiring attention to

- Equipment identification
- Piping system identification
- Belt drive adjustment
- Control system checkout in accordance with ASHRAE *Guideline* 11-2009
- Documentation of system installation
- Lubrication
- Electrical system checkout for overload heater size and function
- Cleaning and degreasing of hydronic piping systems
- Pretreatment of hydronic fluids
- Setup of chemical treatment program for hydronic systems and evaporative apparatus
- Start-up of major equipment items by factory-trained technician
- Testing and balancing
- Planning of preventive maintenance program
- Instruction of owner's operating and maintenance personnel in accordance with proposed ASHRAE *Guideline* GPC 1.3P, Building Operation and Maintenance Training for the HVAC&R Commissioning Process

Maintenance

Basic operating and maintenance data required for makeup air systems may be obtained from the ASHRAE Handbook chapters covering the components. Specific operating instructions are required for makeup air heaters that require changeover from winter to summer conditions, including manual fan speed changes, air distribution pattern adjustment, or heating cycle lockout. Operating and maintenance documentation should comply with ASHRAE *Guideline* 4-2008 (RA13).

Operations handling 100% outdoor air may require more frequent maintenance, such as changing filters, lubricating bearings, and checking the water supply to evaporative coolers/humidifiers. Filters on systems in locations with dirty air require more frequent changing, so a review may determine whether upgrading filter media would be cost-effective. More frequent cleaning of fans' blades and heat transfer surfaces may be required in such locations to maintain airflow and heat transfer performance.

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ANSI. 2021. Laboratory methods of testing air curtains for aerodynamic performance ratings. *Standard* 220-21, Section C408.2.3. American National Standards Institute, New York.

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CHAPTER 29

AIR CLEANERS FOR PARTICULATE CONTAMINANTS

Terminology 29.1
Atmospheric Aerosols 29.2
Aerosol Characteristics 29.2
Air-Cleaning Applications 29.3
Mechanisms of Particle Collection 29.3
Types of Air Cleaners and Performance 29.4
Air Cleaner Test Methods 29.7
Selection and Maintenance 29.10
Air Cleaner Installation 29.13
Safety Considerations 29.14

THIS chapter discusses removal of contaminants from both ventilation and recirculated air used for conditioning building interiors. The filters mentioned in this chapter are primarily used for HVAC systems and for the protection of equipment. Complete air cleaning may require removing of airborne particles, microorganisms, and gaseous contaminants, but this chapter only covers removal of airborne particles and briefly discusses bioaerosols. Chapter 47 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* covers the removal of gaseous contaminants. Chapter 62 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* covers bioaerosols and UV air cleaners in more depth.

The total suspended particulate concentration in applications discussed in this chapter seldom exceeds 2 mg/m^3 and is usually less than 0.2 mg/m^3 of air (Chapter 11 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). This is in contrast to flue gas or exhaust gas from processes, where dust concentrations typically range from 200 to 40 000 mg/m^3. Chapter 46 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* discusses exhaust gas control.

Most air cleaners discussed in this chapter are not used in exhaust gas streams because of the extreme dust concentration, large particle size, high temperature, high humidity, and high airflow rate requirements that may be encountered in process exhaust. However, the air cleaners discussed here are used extensively in supplying makeup air with low particulate concentration to industrial processes.

1. TERMINOLOGY

Definitions

Aerodynamic diameter. The diameter of a spherical particle with a density of 1000 kg/m^3 and the same settling velocity as the irregular particle of interest.

Aerosol. Solid and/or liquid particles suspended in air.

Air cleaner. Device or system for removing contaminants from air in a ventilation system, building or other enclosed space.

Air filter. A device containing filter media, typically mounted in a frame, that is designed to remove particles from an air stream onto the fibers in the *air filter media.*

Air filter media. Portion of a filtration system (such as close-woven textiles, metal screens, papers, nonwoven fabrics, granular beds, or porous media) that effects separation of particles from air.

Air purifier. See *Air cleaner*

Arrestance. Measure of the ability of a filter to remove a standard test from the air passing through it, under given operating conditions. Arrestance is expressed as a percentage by weight of the test dust (ISO 29464).

Bioaerosol. Particles of biological origin suspended in air (ISO 29464).

Dust-holding capacity. Total mass of synthetic loading dust captured by an air-cleaning device added up over all of the incremental dust loading steps.

Duct air cleaner. See *In-duct air cleaner*

Duct-mounted air cleaner. See *In-duct air cleaner*

Electret air filter. An air filter in which the fibers in the filter media contain a one-time initial electrical charge designed to boost particle capture efficiency, particularly early in the life of the filter.

Electrically enhanced air purifier. See *Electrically enhanced air cleaner*

Electrically enhanced air cleaner. A type of electronic air cleaner that includes filter media positioned within an electric field and/or actively ionically charged to increase the particle collection efficiency of the filter media. Additionally, particles may be ionically precharged prior to their arrival at the filter media.

Electronic air cleaner (EAC). An air cleaner that uses electrical power for at least part of the mechanism by which particles are removed from an airstream. Types include electrostatic precipitators (ESPs) and electrically enhanced air purifiers, among others.

Electrostatic precipitator (ESP). A type of electronic air cleaner that uses high-voltage wires or points to charge particles via corona discharge and then move the particles transverse to the airflow to grounded collection plates by the imposition of an electric field via the same or secondary plate high voltage electrodes.

Fibrous air filter. See *Air filter*

Fractional efficiency. See *Particle size removal efficiency*

In-duct air cleaner. An air cleaner designed to be installed in an HVAC duct.

In-room air cleaner. A stand-alone device that includes an air cleaner and a blower, or other means to move air through the air cleaner, in a housing. In-room air cleaners typically have an electrical cord and are plugged into an electrical outlet.

In-room air purifier. See *In-Room Air Cleaner*

Mechanical media air filter. An air filter in which particle removal is accomplished via mechanical filtration mechanisms only and not via electrostatic effects.

Media air filter. See *Air Filter*

Most penetrating particle size (MPPS). The size of particles that most easily pass through a filter, whether the filter is infiltration or air purifier system.

Particle size removal efficiency. The fraction or percentage of particles retained by an air cleaner for a given particle-size range.

Particulate air filter. Device for separating solid and/or liquid particles from an airstream passing through the device.

Particulate matter (PM). Solid and/or liquid particles of various sizes.

Penetration. The fraction or percentage of particles that pass through an air cleaner for a given particle-size range.

Portable air purifier. See *In-room air cleaner*

Pressure drop. See *Resistance to airflow*

Removal Efficiency by Particle Size. See *Particle size removal efficiency*

Resistance to airflow. Difference in absolute (static) pressure between two points in an airflow system. This parameter is often called pressure drop.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 2.4, Particulate Air Contaminants and Particulate Contaminant Removal Equipment.

Resistance to airflow. Difference in absolute (static) pressure between two points in an airflow system. This parameter is often called pressure drop.

Respirable fraction. The subfraction of the inhaled particles that penetrates into the alveolar region of the lung (i.e., includes the respiratory bronchioles, the alveolar ducts and sacs)

Room air cleaner. See *In-room air cleaner*

Room air purifier. See *In-room air cleaner*

Stand-alone air cleaner. See *In-room air cleaner*

Acronyms

AFI. Air Filter Institute.
AHRI. Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute.
AHU. Air-handling unit.
ASME. American Society of Mechanical Engineers.
BI/BO. Bag-in/bag-out.
CEN. Comité Européen de Normalisation.
DEHS. Di-ethyl-hexyl-sebacate.
DHC. Dust-holding capacity.
DOP. Dioctyl phthalate.
EN. European norm (European standard).
EPA. Environmental Protection Agency.
EB. Existing buildings.
ETS. Environmental tobacco smoke.
HEPA. High-efficiency particulate air.
IEST. Institute of Environmental Sciences and Technology.
IPA. Isopropyl alcohol.
ISO. International Organization for Standardization.
LCC. Life-cycle cost.
LEED. Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design.
MERV. Minimum efficiency reporting value.
MIL-STD. U.S. Military standard.
MPPS. Most penetrating particle size.
MSHA. Mine Safety and Health Administration.
NAFA. National Air Filtration Association.
NC. New construction.
NIOSH. National Institute for Occupational Safety and Health.
NIST. National Institute of Standards and Technology.
PAO. Polyalphaolefin.
PM. Particulate matter.
PSE. Particle size removal efficiency.
PSL. Polystyrene latex.
UL. Underwriters Laboratory.
ULPA. Ultra-low particulate air.
VAV. Variable air volume.

2. ATMOSPHERIC AEROSOLS

Atmospheric contaminants are a complex mixture of smokes, mists, fumes, dry granular particles, bioaerosols, and natural and synthetic fibers. When suspended in a gas such as air, this mixture is called an **aerosol**. A sample of atmospheric aerosol usually contains soot and smoke, silica, clay, decayed animal and vegetable matter, organic materials in the form of lint and plant fibers, and metallic fragments. It may also contain living organisms, such as mold spores, bacteria, and plant pollens, which may cause diseases or allergic responses. (Chapter 11 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* contains further information on atmospheric contaminants.) A sample of atmospheric aerosol gathered at any point generally contains materials common to that locality, together with other components that originated at a distance but were transported by air currents or diffusion. These components and their concentrations vary with the geography of the locality (urban or rural), season of the year, weather, direction and strength of the wind, and proximity of dust sources.

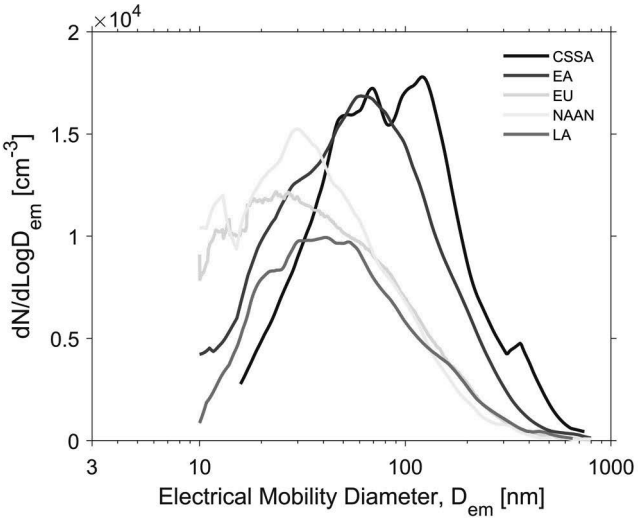

Fig. 1 Mobility Versus Particle Diameter

Median number particle size distributions for each geographical region (CSSA = Central, South, and Southeast Asia; EA = East Asia; EU = Europe; NAAN = North America, Australia, & New Zealand; LA = Latin America) (Wu and Boor 2021)

Aerosol sizes range from 0.01 µm and smaller for freshly formed combustion particles and radon progeny; to 0.1 µm for aged cooking and cigarette smokes; from 0.1 to 10 µm for airborne dust, microorganisms, and allergens; and up to 100 µm and larger for airborne soil, pollens, and allergens.

Number concentrations of atmospheric aerosols generally peak at submicron sizes and decrease rapidly as the particulate size increases above 1 µm. In fact, number concentrations of particles in urban aerosols are predominantly below 0.5 µm, dependent upon geographic location.

For a given size, the concentration can vary by several orders of magnitude over time and by location, particularly near an aerosol source, such as human activities, equipment, furnishings, and pets (Block and Bokalders 2010). This wide range of particulate size and concentration makes it impossible to design one cleaner for all applications.

3. AEROSOL CHARACTERISTICS

The characteristics of aerosols that most affect air filter performance include particle size and shape, mass, concentration, and electrical properties. The most important of these is particle size. Figure 3 in Chapter 11 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* gives data on the sizes and characteristics of a wide range of airborne particles that may be encountered.

Particle size in this discussion refers to aerodynamic particle size. Particles less than 0.1 µm in diameter are generally referred to as **ultrafine-mode** or **nanoparticles**, those between 0.1 and 2.5 µm are termed **fine mode**, and those larger than 2.5 µm as **coarse mode**. Whereas ultrafine- and fine-mode particles may be formed together, fine- and coarse-mode particles typically originate by separate mechanisms, are transformed separately, have different chemical compositions, and require different control strategies. Vehicle exhaust is a major source of ultrafine particles. Ultrafines are minimally affected by gravitational settling and can remain suspended for days at a time. Fine-mode particles generally originate from condensation or are directly emitted as combustion products. Many microorganisms (bacteria and fungi) either are in this size range or produce components this size. These particles are less likely to be removed by gravitational settling and are just as likely to deposit on

vertical surfaces as on horizontal surfaces. Coarse-mode particles are typically produced by mechanical actions such as erosion and friction. Coarse particles are more easily removed by gravitational settling, and thus have a shorter airborne lifetime.

For industrial hygiene purposes, particles ≤ 5 μm in diameter are considered **respirable particles (RSPs)** because a large percentage of this size range has been shown to reach the alveolar region of the lungs. A cutoff of 5.0 μm includes 80 to 90% of the particles that can reach the functional pulmonary region of the lungs (James et al. 1991; Phalen et al. 1991). Willeke and Baron (1993) describe a detailed aerosol sampling technique for RSPs, including the use of impactors. See also the discussion in the section on Sizes of Airborne Particles in Chapter 11 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

In the United States, **particulate matter (PM)** levels in outdoor air are regulated by the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). Outdoor PM is a complex mixture of small particles and liquid droplets; their effects on health are related to size. Smaller particles have more impact because they penetrate deeper into the respiratory system. Currently, there are two regulated size ranges:

- **PM_{10}.** Inhalable particles with diameters that are generally 10 μm and smaller according to the EPA; typical sources include road dust and industrial emissions
- **$PM_{2.5}$.** Fine inhalable particles with diameters that are generally 2.5 μm and smaller; the main sources are industrial emissions and combustion exhaust from automobiles, power plants, and heating systems

PM_1, which is not regulated, consists of fine and ultrafine particles of less than 1 μm aerodynamic diameter.

The U.S. Clean Air Act requires the EPA to impose both primary standards designed to protect public health, and secondary standards intended to protect against adverse environmental effects. The limits presently in place (Federal Register 2013) are shown in Table 1. There is no filtration requirement for areas of noncompliance.

Bioaerosols are a diverse class of particles of biological origin. They include bacteria, fungal spores, fungal fragments, pollen grains, subpollen particles, viruses, pet- and pest-associated allergens, and plant debris (Fröhlich-Nowoisky et al. 2016). They are of particular concern in indoor air because of their association with allergies and asthma and their ability to cause disease. Chapters 10 and 11 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* contain more detailed descriptions of these contaminants.

Bioaerosols range in size from 0.01 to 100 μm. Single bacterial cells are approximately 1 μm or less in aerodynamic diameter; however, they are often transported as larger bacterial cell agglomerates (~2 to 5 μm) or attached to other biological and abiotic particles. Unicellular fungal spores are generally 2 to 5 μm in aerodynamic diameter and multicellular fungal spores are larger than 10 μm (Després et al. 2012; Qian et al. 2012). Fungal fragments are typically less than 1 μm in size (Mensah-Attipoe et al. 2016). Pollen grains range in size from 10 to 100 μm (Després et al. 2012), while subpollen particles span ~0.01 μm to several micrometers in size (Taylor et al. 2004). Individual viruses can be as small as 0.02 to 0.03 μm, but are typically carried on larger particles (Verreault et al. 2008). Pet- and pest-associated allergens are approximately 1 to ≥20 μm in size (O'Meara and Tovey 2000). Virus- or bacteria-containing particles (from human sneezing, coughing, singing, etc.) include saliva/sputum and other compounds from the human respiratory tract, such that these particles will be bigger (often much bigger) than the individual virus or bacterium.

Throughout the COVID-19 pandemic, the terms *droplet*, *droplet nuclei*, *aerosol particle*, etc., were used in different ways by different people, especially across the infectious disease to aerosol science areas. To clearly understand these discussions, determine which use of the words is important in context. However, generally speaking *drop* or *droplet* is used to mean larger pieces of wet saliva/sputum/biological content. Depending on the person and time, this may mean different sizes, including bigger than 5 μm, bigger than 10 μm, or even bigger than 100 μm. When used, *droplet* most often means bigger particles that will fall out of still air very quickly. *Droplet nuclei* is used to mean smaller particles, but the use seems to be less specific. *Aerosols* or *aerosol particles* are used to indicate particles that can stay in the air for many minutes, hours, or longer. In this context, it may mean particles emitted from a person at that size or that dried down from bigger particles.

Table 1 U.S. EPA Standards for Particulate Matter in Outdoor Air

Type of Standard	Time Period Applicable	PM_{10}, μg/m³	$PM_{2.5}$, μg/m³
Primary	24 h	150	35
	1 yr	—	12
Secondary	24 h	150	35
	1 yr	—	15

Source: EPA (2015).

4. AIR-CLEANING APPLICATIONS

Different air-cleaning applications require different degrees of air cleaning effectiveness. In some industrial environments, ventilation removing only the larger dust particles from the airstream may produce acceptable cleanliness of the structure, protection of mechanical equipment, and employee health.

Certain industrial processes may also generate finer particulate contaminants that can impact employee health and may require a higher level of filtration.

In other applications, surface discoloration must be prevented. Unfortunately, the smaller components of atmospheric aerosol are the worst offenders in smudging and discoloring building interiors. Air cleaners or medium- to high-efficiency filters are required to remove smaller particles, especially the respirable fraction, which often must be controlled for comfort and health reasons. In cleanrooms or when radioactive or other dangerous particles are present, high- or ultrahigh-efficiency filters should be selected. For more information on cleanrooms, see Chapter 19 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Major factors influencing filter design and selection include (1) degree of air cleanliness required, (2) specific particle size range or aerosols that require filtration, (3) aerosol concentration, (4) resistance to airflow through the filter, (5) design filter for sealing and face velocity to achieve published performance and to include the capability of HVAC system to push air through it, (6) change-out cycle requirements, (7) energy consumption requirements, (8) special disposal mandates, and (9) resistance to certain conditions (physical, chemical, or biological).

5. MECHANISMS OF PARTICLE COLLECTION

In particle collection, air cleaners made of fibrous media rely on the following five main principles or mechanisms (Figure 2):

Straining or Sieving. The coarsest kind of filtration strains particles through an opening smaller than the particle being removed. It is most often observed as the collection of large particles and lint on the filter surface. The mechanism is not adequate to achieve the filtration of submicrometre aerosols through fibrous matrices, which occurs through other physical mechanisms, as follows.

Inertial Impingement. When particles are large or dense enough that they cannot follow the airstream around a fiber, they cross over streamlines, hit the fiber, and remain there if the attraction is strong enough. With flat-panel and other minimal-media-area filters having high air velocities (where the effect of inertia is most pronounced), the particle may not adhere to the fiber because drag and bounce

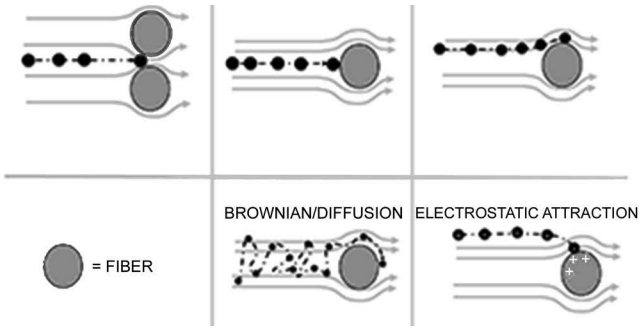

Fig. 2 Collection Mechanisms for Filter Fiber

forces are so high. In this case, a viscous coating (preferably odorless and nonmigrating) is applied to the fiber to enhance retention of the particles. This adhesive coating is critical to metal mesh impingement filter performance. This is also called inertial impaction.

Interception. Particles that follow the airstream close enough to a fiber that the particle contacts the fiber and remains there mainly because of van der Waals forces (i.e., weak intermolecular attractions between temporary dipoles). The adhesion process depends on air velocity through the media being low enough not to dislodge the particles; particles may be dislodged by other particles, causing shedding through the filter with repeated bounces. Interception is the predominant capture mechanism in extended-media filters such as bag and deep-pleated rigid cartridge types.

Diffusion. The path of very small particles is not smooth but erratic and random within the airstream. This is caused by gas molecules in the air bombarding them (Brownian motion), producing an erratic path that brings the particles close enough to a media fiber to be captured by interception. As more particles are captured, a concentration gradient forms in the region of the fiber, further enhancing filtration by diffusion and interception. The effects of diffusion increase with decreasing particle size and media velocity.

Electrostatic Effects. Particle or media electrostatic charge can produce changes in dust collection affected by the electrical properties of the airstream. Some particles may carry a natural charge. Passive electrostatic (without a power source) filter fibers are often electrostatically charged during their manufacture or (in some materials) by blowing dry air through the media. Charges on the particle and media fibers can produce a strong attracting force if opposite. The influence of this mechanism is highest when the media is new and clean. As the filter captures dust on the fibers, the particles will mask the charge, leading to lower collection efficiency.

Electrostatic precipitators, which are a class of electronic air cleaners, capture particles by charging them with high-voltage wires and then capturing the particles on oppositely charged plates. The mechanism is similar to that used with charged media, except the charging of the particles is intentionally induced by the air cleaner and the devices require power to operate.

Ionizers may be used to enhance particle capture by producing charged particles that will stick to a following filter's fibers. This mechanism is similar to that of the charged filters of electronic air cleaners in that oppositely charged particles and collection surfaces are fundamental to the collection of particles. Ionizers are also used to create ions that attach to particles in the air, which in turn leads to agglomeration (particles sticking together to form larger particles that are more easily removed by a filter than the original, smaller particles). Ionizers not immediately followed by a filter may cause charged or agglomerated particles to stick to other surfaces such as walls, floors, drapes, and lungs.

Chemical Effects. Chemical effects can also remove particles from air. Reactive air cleaners (RACs) include a variety of technologies that rely on some form of chemistry to work. They require power to operate. RACs may introduce reactive species into the air that may reduce particles of some chemical contents to CO_2 and water or other intermediary species (e.g., organic particles will react with ozone, whereas aluminosilicates may not). Since the mechanisms vary across the types of devices and are not clearly understood, they are not elucidated here.

6. TYPES OF AIR CLEANERS AND PERFORMANCE

Common air cleaners for particulate removal are broadly grouped as described below. These types of air cleaner exist in both HVAC and in-room styles. Most of the discussion below is aimed at HVAC-type devices, but the technology details are applicable to both. Users of in-room air cleaners (IRAC) should refer to Chapter 66 in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more details specific to in-room applications.

Common air cleaners can be grouped as follows:

- **Media filters** constructed from fibers in various configurations
- **Electronic air cleaners**, which rely on electrostatic effects for removal efficiency and require supplied power to operate
- Air cleaners that rely on **chemical effects** to remove particles and usually require supplied power to operate
- **Combination air cleaners** that use two or more technologies. In addition to those mentioned previously, they may include gas-phase removal or bioaerosol removal/inactivation technologies such as carbon filters or ultraviolet (UV) lamps

Media Filters

Media filters are typically made from filter media in the form of paper or batting consisting of fibers in various types, sizes, and configurations. The units collect dust directly in and on the fibers at various efficiencies and with varying dust-holding capabilities. They can be static or renewable media devices and do not need separate power sources other than that needed for the HVAC or IRAC fan. The filters are discussed in more detail below, in approximate order of increasing particle removal efficiency.

Panel Filters. Also known as **impingement filters**, these are flat pads. Thus, the media velocity is always equal to the duct velocity. These filters can be constructed from a variety of media, including spun glass, synthetic fibers such as polyester, polyurethane foam, natural fibers, dry plastics, and various metals that may be fibrous or expanded sheets. Using these coarse fiber media, these filters are typically characterized by a low initial pressure drop and efficiencies not above MERV 6.

As filter efficiency increases, resistance to airflow often increases for the same airflow rate. Therefore, to achieve greater filtration efficiencies while maintaining a pressure drop within the design limits of HVAC systems, the media area exposed to the airstream may be increased. These **extended-surface filters** include pleated panels, mini-pleats, bag (or pocket) filters, and compact filters. The products most commonly use nonwoven fiber mats or blankets of varying thicknesses, fiber sizes, and densities.

The most commonly used media for the construction of **pleated panels** include carded and spunbond synthetics such as polyester and polypropylene as well as natural fibers such as cotton. Pleat separation may be maintained through the use of a variety of techniques, including the pleating of an expanded metal mesh layer along with the media, the use of paperboard or polymer combs, hot-melt glue strips, adhesive-coated string, or corrugated metal. New technologies that are becoming more popular include materials such as cellulose and polylactic acid (PLA) fibers, which can be used to meet certified biobased requirements. These filters typically fall into the MERV 7 to MERV 13 efficiency range.

Before 2000, **bag** or **pocket filters** used air-laid micro-fiberglass almost exclusively; however, since then a number of nonwoven synthetic media have been developed that use materials such as polypropylene and polyester. The media are most often constructed of meltblown and spunbond combinations and are almost always charged to achieve a given efficiency at a lower resistance to airflow than uncharged types. The use of nanofibers has recently seen more widespread use for enhancing the efficiency of these products.

The individual pockets may be stitched or heat-sealed around the perimeter. The desired spacing between the media layers forming the pocket is controlled either by a span stitch or media web. This prevents the pocket from "ballooning" and restricting the airflow. The completed pockets are then assembled into a frame parallel to each other in the direction of the airflow. These products are normally offered in the MERV 10 to MERV 16 range.

Compact filters include both **box filters** and **mini-pleat** products. The products cover the same efficiency range as pocket filters; however, as the name implies, they can be used in installations where there is insufficient depth to accommodate a bag filter. Box filters, also referred to as rigid boxes or cells, use the same media as bag filters.

Because of the tight spacing requirements between pleats, special media were developed for mini-pleat products. These include both wet-laid nonwovens as well as synthetics. Spacing between the pleats is physically maintained by use of corrugated aluminum, hot-melt beads, or string spacers. Some hybrid versions use a media that can be embossed for maintaining spacing. These media may be supported by wire mesh or may be laminated to a stiffer nonwoven material (e.g., a spunbond material) to achieve the rigidity requirements and to protect the more fragile efficiency layer from abrasion. In still other designs, the media may be self supporting or, in the case of bag filters, the design uses the airstream to inflate the pockets and maintain spacing.

Extended-surface filters may also be constructed using expanded polytetrafluoroethylene (ePTFE) membranes. These products typically fall into HEPA classifications but can also be found at the very high end of the MERV range. Applications may include semiconductor, microelectronics, pharmaceutical, and gas turbine inlet filtration.

Efficiencies for extended-surface filters are usually higher than those for panel filters. The dust-holding capacities are also generally higher than for impingement filters simply due to the increased media area. As an example, a 610 × 610 × 305 mm deep V-cell product may use up to 18.5 m^2 of media area and have a typical media velocity of 0.05 m/s at 1 m/s system flow. A flat panel filter in the same installation would have a media velocity of 2.5 m/s. Hence a higher efficiency media may exhibit more resistance to airflow, but with significantly more media area the media velocity may be lowered.

Initial resistance on an extended-surface filter varies with the choice of media and filter geometry. Depth in direction of airflow varies from ~25 to 900 mm.

Electret filters require no power in HVAC installations and are composed of electrostatically charged media fibers. Various manufacturing processes are used, many of them producing mats that contain both positively and negatively charged fibers. Charged-fiber filter efficiency is determined by both the normal collection mechanisms of a media filter and the strong local electrostatic effects (related to the amount of electrostatic charge). The effects improve clean filter efficiency over similar uncharged media without increasing resistance to airflow. However, ultrafine-particle dust collected on the fibers usually reduces the efficiency as electrets age. Electret filters are also discussed in ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2, Appendix J.

HEPA (high-efficiency particulate air) and **ULPA** (ultra-low-penetration air) are filters designed to target the MPPS for a given flow rate. The original U.S. MIL standard for efficiency of a HEPA filter specified that it must be a minimum of 99.97% efficient for 0.3 μm particles. There are now a number of differing HEPA filter standards on the market that are described in more detail in section 8 of this chapter. HEPA and ULPA filters are made in extended-surface configurations of deep folds or a mini-pleat style of submicrometer glass fiber paper. Synthetic materials, such as ePTFE and nanofibers, are also common materials for HEPA/ULPA. These are usually combined with a spunbond scrim layer to protect the membrane.

These filters are the standard for cleanroom, nuclear, and toxic particulate applications and are increasingly used in medical and pharmaceutical applications. Traditional HEPA filters for HVAC use are often 300 mm deep and the initial pressure drop can be between 125 and 250 Pa. As such, they are typically not used in residential HVAC systems, where system blowers cannot handle the extra resistance to airflow. Note that there are so-called "bypass HEPA" filter systems on the market that contain a fan and small HEPA filter connected to an HVAC duct so that a portion of the air is drawn through the HEPA filter, with the remainder passing unfiltered down the duct. The overall single-pass efficiency of such a system will necessarily be far less than a HEPA filter. Standards that follow the original HEPA definition of 99.97% efficiency for 0.3 μm diameter particles include

- United States *Military Standard* MIL-STD-282
- United States Department of Energy DOE-STD-3020-2015
- American Society of Mechanical Engineers ASME AG-1
- Institute of Environmental Sciences and Technology IEST-RP-CC001

Alternative HEPA definitions include those found in **ISO 29463-1** (ISO 35H ≥ 99.95% efficient at MPPS, and ISO 40H ≥ 99.99% efficient at MPPS), and the one from **EN-1822-1** (HEPA H13 ≥ 99.75% efficient at MPPS).

Prefiltering. Using less efficient prefilters upstream of extended-surface filters is common and is sometimes justified economically by the potentially longer life of the main filters. Economic considerations include prefilter material cost, changeout labor, and increased fan power. Generally, prefilters should be considered only if they can substantially reduce the part of the dust that may plug the protected filter and extend the final filter's lifetime. A prefilter usually is at least a MERV 8, with 6 as an occasional lower end. They are commonly rated up to MERV 15. They are usually not more than 3 MERVs lower than the final filter. There can be either a two- or three-stage system set up for a HEPA/ULPA filter. A two-stage would have a prefilter in the MERV 11 to 15 range before the HEPA/ULPA. A three-stage would have a MERV 1 to 10 as an initial, a MERV 8 to 15 as a middle, and a HEPA/ULPA as a final.

A single filter gage may be installed when a panel prefilter is placed adjacent to a final filter. Because the prefilter is frequently changed on a schedule, the final filter pressure drop can be read without the prefilter in place every time the prefilter is changed. For maximum accuracy and economy of prefilter use, two gages can be used. Some air filter housings are available with pressure taps between the pre- and final filter tracks to accommodate this arrangement.

Temporary prefilters protecting higher-efficiency filters are worthwhile during construction to capture heavy loads of coarse dust.

HEPA and ULPA filters should always be protected by prefilters.

Removal efficiencies and typical operating conditions for different types of media filters are listed in Table 2.

Electronic Air Cleaners. In the past, the term *electronic air cleaner* (EAC) was somewhat synonymous with the term electrostatic precipitator (ESP). More recently, EAC has been used to describe a wide variety of powered air cleaners, including those that

Table 2 Typical Properties and Operating Conditions for Media filters

		Typical Operating Conditions			
Filter Type	**Typical MERV**	**Initial Resistance to Airflow, Pa**	**Final Resistance to Airflow, Pa**	**Duct Velocity, m/s**	**Media Velocity, m/s**
Panel	1 to 6	13 to 63	125 to 250	1.5 to 2.5	Same as duct velocity
Low-efficiency renewable/ cleanable	4 to 6	100 to 125	125 to 250	1.5 to 2.5	Same as duct velocity
Extended-surface	7 to 16	63 to 250	125 to 375	up to 3	0.03 to 0.5 for intermediate efficiency
Electret	5 to 16	50 to 250	125 to 375	1.5 to 2.5	0.05 to 1
HEPA/ULPA	More efficient than MERV 16	125	500	0.25 to 2.5	0.25 to 0.5

use electrostatic effects to reduce or remove air particulate pollutants and those powered devices aimed at gas-phase pollutants such as ultraviolet photocatalytic oxidation (UVPCO) devices. Electronic air cleaners that use electrostatic effects to remove particles are available in many designs but fall into two major categories: (1) electrostatic, plate-type precipitators and (2) electrically enhanced air filtration. Various types of ionizers also fall into this category.

Corona discharge is used in most electronic air cleaners designed to remove particulates from the air. Corona discharge is a form of electrical discharge in which a small region of plasma is formed at an electrode with a relatively small radius of curvature as compared to the geometry in the rest of the system. A wire and plate are classic examples of such disparate electrodes, although metal points or carbon brushes are also often used as corona electrodes. In such a system, as the electric potential between the electrodes is increased, an electron avalanche will be initiated at or near the sharp electrode, and a small region of plasma (glow corona) will be formed. When properly designed, the voltage is held at that potential and not permitted to increase to the point at which an arc would occur between the electrodes. At the edge of the corona region, ions are formed, which flow along electric field lines to the ground electrode. The space charge created by the ions is typically used to charge particles in electronic air cleaners designed for the removal of particles. A complex series of reactions occurs within the corona plasma and reactive species are formed, most notably ozone. The amount of ozone generated is typically roughly proportional to the amount of current flowing through the discharge electrode, but other factors can influence the amount of ozone produced, including electrode polarity, electrode tip size, and electrode material.

Electrostatic precipitators (ESPs), which require a power source during operation, are electronic air cleaners that create an electric field transverse to the airflow to move charged particles along field lines to grounded plates. Very large single-stage ESPs, in which high-voltage corona wires are suspended between a series of parallel grounded plates, are often used in coal-fired power plants and cement factories. Such ESPs may be 12 m tall and have plate spacings on the order of 300 mm. ESPs designed for HVAC systems, on the other hand, are typically two-stage devices, consisting of a first section containing corona wires and plates, and a second section consisting of alternating high voltage and grounded plates. The second section is more effective at removing smaller particulates due to reduced electrohydrodynamic turbulence in that section.

The first stage of a two-stage ESP is the ionization and particle charging section, in which the small-diameter corona wires, typically at a positive DC voltage between 5 and 25 kV, are suspended equidistant between grounded plates. Ions created by the corona discharge at the wire flow toward the ground plates along electric field lines and charge particles in the airstream. As particles accumulate charge, they are also influenced by the electric field and migrate toward the grounded plates. The largest particles will acquire the most charge and they, along with smaller particles that are already near the plates, will strike the plate and have a high probability of being collected there. The remainder of the charged particles then pass into the second stage, the collection section.

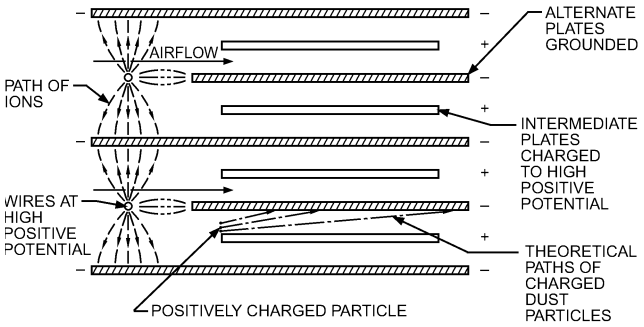

Fig. 3 Cross Section of Plate-Type Precipitator Air Cleaner

The collection section consists of a series of alternating high voltage and grounded parallel plates. The parallel plates set up a uniform electric field transverse to the air flow and the charged particles migrate towards the grounded plate as they move through the section. Voltage differential can be the same as the differential between the sires and plates in the charging section or could be a smaller potential of the plates are spaced more closely together. Once the particles reach the grounded plate, they are removed from the airstream and collected by the plates. Particle retention is a combination of electrical and intermolecular adhesion forces and may be augmented by special oils or adhesives on the plates. Figure 3 shows a typical electrostatic plate-type precipitator cell.

In lieu of positive direct current, a negative potential also functions on generally the same principle, but typically generates more ozone. With voltages of 5 to 25 kV (dc), safety measures are required. A typical arrangement makes the air cleaner inoperative when the doors are removed for cleaning the cells or servicing the power pack. Electronic air cleaners typically operate from a 120 or 240 V (ac) single-phase electrical service. The high voltage supplied to the air cleaner cells is normally created with solid-state power supplies. The electric power consumption ranges from 40 to 85 W per m^3/s of air cleaner capacity.

Electrically Enhanced Air Filtration. Electrically enhanced air cleaners use high voltage to enhance the collection capability of fibrous air filters by polarizing and/or charging the filter fibers. They typically fall into two categories: (1) those that use the polarization effect alone, and 2) those that use ionization charging and polarization. In a polarizing system, the fibrous filter is placed in an electric field strong enough to induce dipoles in/on the fibers. The localized region of charge on the fibers serves to attract particles of the opposite charge and neutral particles with induced dipoles. Although filter enhancement due to polarization alone is typically not as significant as that due to particle or fiber charging, it is a measurable effect (Bergman et al, 1983). In an ionizing electrically enhanced filtration system, the fibers and/or particles are charged

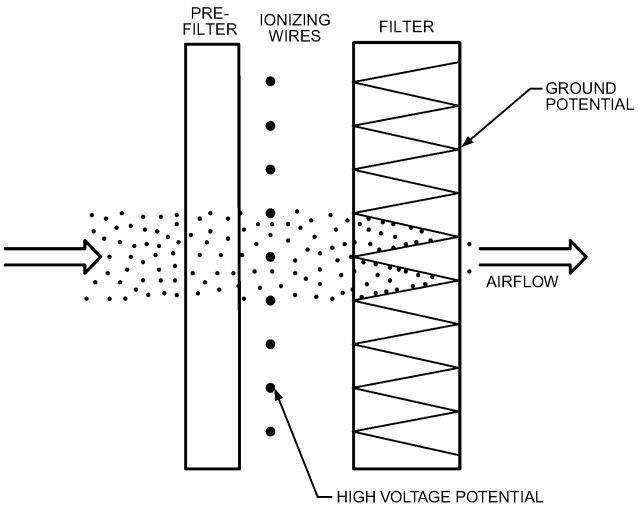

Fig. 4 Electrically Enhanced Air Cleaner with Prefilter

via a corona electrode system and the fibers are also typically polarized. Advantages to doing so include increased efficiency without an increase in resistance to airflow. Figure 4 shows that the air cleaners consist of an ionizing section and a filtration section. The ionizing section has a prefilter to prevent large debris from entering the air filter and to focus the electrostatic field. The air is charged in a high-voltage ionizing section. In the ionization section, the ionizer is connected to a high-voltage power supply and the particulate is charged. The charged particles are collected in the media filter at earth ground potential.

Optional features are often available for electronic air cleaners. Downstream filters collect particulates that agglomerate and blow off the cell plates. These are used mainly where heavy contaminant loading occurs and extension of the cleaning cycle is desired. Cell collector plates may be coated with special oils, adhesives, or detergents to improve both particle retention and particle removal during cleaning. High-efficiency dry extended-media area filters are also used as downstream filters in special designs. The electronic air cleaner used in such a system improves the service life of the dry filter and collects small particles such as smoke.

Ionizers employed independently of an ESP or electrically enhanced filtration system use ions produced by high voltages to charge particles to cause agglomeration resulting in better capture by a filter downstream, or to lead particles to plate out on oppositely charged surfaces such as walls, floors, and people.

A **negative ionizer** uses the principle of particle charging but does not use a collecting section. Particles enter the ionizer of the unit, receive an electrical charge, and then migrate to a grounded surface closest to the travel path.

Space Charge. Particulates that pass through an ionizer and are charged, but not removed, carry the electrical charge into the space. If continued on a large scale, a space charge builds up, which tends to drive these charged particles to walls and interior surfaces. Thus, a low-efficiency electronic air cleaner used in areas of high ambient dirt concentrations (or a malfunctioning unit), can blacken walls faster than if no cleaning device were used (SMACNA, 2010).

Other types of EAC include needlepoint ionization (NPBI), dry hydrogen peroxide (DHP), and photocatalytic oxidation (PCO), which may reduce certain types of particles using chemical reactions with them. Although these EAC lack substantial verification data for efficacy or safety at this point, the COVID-19 crisis has dramatically increased use of EACs. Some EAC technologies with more limited applications before the pandemic have been used in wider applications with exposure to an increased number of occupants. The safety concerns outlined in this chapter apply to both new installations as well as the many devices that were expedited into service for the alleviation of pandemic concerns.

Combining air cleaners involves installing air cleaners in sequence in an HVAC system. For example, as mentioned above, an ESP may be used as a particle coagulator (agglomerator) with a fibrous media filter downstream to catch the agglomerated particles blown off the plates. The benefits of combining different air cleaning processes vary. In addition to combining different particle removal technologies, an air cleaning system may combine particle removal with gas-phase or bioaerosol removal technologies (e.g., a particle filter followed by a carbon bed then a UV lamp system). Care should be taken to be sure that the devices work well together. For example, a filter immediately downstream of an ionizer may lead to better filtration or may limit the ability of the ionizer to charge particles in the rooms.

Combination air cleaners include more than one technology within the unit. These may include, for example, a HEPA and a UV lamp or a MERV 13 filter with a carbon bed. Combination units are most commonly found in IRAC. In some cases, multiple technologies can allow the device to treat more than one type of pollutant, as in the case of a media filter and a carbon bed addressing particles and gases. In others, one or more technologies are used in combination to remove the same pollutant (e.g., filter and ionizer). For combination units, consider the benefits of each technology and the possible interactions between them. The difference between combining air cleaners and combination air cleaners is simply that *combination* air cleaners are sold as a single unit, whereas the *combining* ones are sold separately.

7. AIR CLEANER TEST METHODS

The distinguishing operating characteristics of particle removal air cleaners are particle size removal efficiency, resistance to airflow, service life, and life-cycle cost. Quickly stated, **efficiency** measures the ability of the air cleaner to remove particles from an airstream. Minimum efficiency during the life of the filter is the most meaningful characteristic for most filters and applications. **Resistance to airflow** (or simply resistance) is the static pressure drop differential across the filter at a given face velocity. The term *static pressure differential* is interchangeable with pressure drop and resistance. **Life-cycle cost** is the evaluation of device performance in the application in terms of overall cost, along with filter service life, including element cost, energy consumption, maintenance, disposal, etc. The discussion below introduces relevant test methods from ASHRAE and other organizations. Refer to the actual methods for more details.

Air filter testing is complex, and no individual test adequately describes all filters or air cleaners. Ideally, performance testing of equipment should simulate operation under actual conditions and evaluate the characteristics important to the equipment user. Although the filters are available and tested at higher air velocity, most AHU manufacturers design filter banks to be operated at 2.5 m/s or below. Wide variations in the amount and type of particles in the air being cleaned make evaluation difficult. Another complication is the difficulty of closely relating measurable performance to the specific requirements of users. Recirculated air tends to have a larger proportion of lint than does outdoor air. However, performance tests should strive to simulate actual use as closely as possible.

Air cleaner test methods have been developed by the heating and air-conditioning industry, the automotive industry, the atomic energy industry, and government and military agencies. In 2005, the ISO reactivated technical committee TC 142, Cleaning Equipment for Air and Other Gases, whose scope includes test methods for particle filters of various types and efficiencies, particle filter media, and room air cleaners. ASHRAE has cooperated closely with TC 142,

and several ASHRAE documents have been used in development of TC 142 standards.

General Ventilation (HVAC) Testing

Several tests have become standard in general ventilation applications in the United States. In 1968, the test techniques developed by the U.S. National Bureau of Standards (now the National Institute of Standards and Technology [NIST]) and the Air Filter Institute (AFI) were unified (with minor changes) into a single test procedure, ASHRAE *Standard* 52-1968. Siegel (2002) and Whitby et al. (1956) give details of the original codes. ASHRAE *Standard* 52-1968 was discontinued in 2009 and replaced by ASHRAE Standard 52.2. Other important standards discussed below include ISO 16890, past European standard EN 779, and standards for testing HEPA and ULPA filters.

ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2. ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2-2017 contains **minimum efficiency reporting values (MERVs)** for air cleaner particle size efficiency. In 2008, the standard incorporated arrestance testing from the discontinued ASHRAE *Standard* 52.1. Table 3 provides an approximate cross-reference for air cleaners tested under discontinued ASHRAE *Standards* 52.1 and 52.2. Currently, there is no ASHRAE standard for testing electronic air cleaners; the current industry-accepted test method for electronic air cleaners is AHRI *Standard* 680. This test involves loading the filter with dust that does not contain a conductive component and allows comparison to media filtration.

ASHRAE Particle Size Removal Efficiency (PSE) Test. ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2 prescribes a way to test air-cleaning devices for removal efficiency by particle size while addressing two air cleaner performance characteristics important to users: the ability of the device to remove particles from the airstream and its resistance to airflow. In this method, air cleaner testing is conducted at a specific airflow based on the upper limit of the air cleaner's application range. Airflows are based on specific face velocities between 0.60 and 3.80 m/s, which yields between 0.22 and 1.4 m^3/s for a nominal 610 by 610 mm filter. The test aerosol consists of laboratory-generated potassium chloride particles dispersed in the airstream. Optical particle counters size and count the particles in 12 defined, geometric logarithmic-scale, equally distributed particle size ranges both upstream and downstream for efficiency determinations. The test encompasses 0.3 to 10 μm particles. The clean-filter efficiency test is followed by five dust loadings, using ASHRAE dust, to increase the pressure drop across the filter. Efficiency tests are performed after each dust loading.

A set of particle size removal efficiency performance curves is developed from the test. The minimum efficiency value in each size channel is used as a composite curve representing performance in the range of sizes. Efficiencies on the composite curve are averaged for small, medium, and large particles; these averages are used to determine the MERV of the air cleaner. Since 2020, the same values are also used to calculate PM efficiencies ($PM_{52.2}10$, $PM_{52.2}2.5$, and $PM_{52.2}1$) to meet the needs of those working with PM data. A complete test report includes (1) a summary of the test, (2) removal efficiency curves of the clean devices at each of the loading steps, (3) a composite minimum removal efficiency curve, (4) the MERV, (5) the PM efficiencies, and (6) resistance/pressure drop curves.

In 2008, Appendix J on conditioning was added as an optional part of *Standard* 52.2. If used, this conditioning step replaces the current first (small) dust loading. This step simulates the efficiency drop seen in many charged filters in actual use: the high concentration of 40 to 50 nm aerosol exposes the filter to many particles of a size common in ambient and indoor air. This step does not completely remove the charge on the fibers. When Appendix J is used in a full *Standard* 52.2 test, the nomenclature used to report results is MERV-A (ASHRAE 2008).

ASHRAE 52.2 only official covers media filters in the standard test, so it does not officially include electronic air cleaners. This is largely due to the carbon content of the loading dust that may short out electronic devices and the lack of a consensus non-pressure drop test dust loading endpoint for devices that do not increase noticeably in pressure drop. Still, the procedures for the clean filter and correlation tests may be used to determine the particle size dependent efficiency for these devices as long as the report is labeled a modified test or otherwise not a formal 52.2 test.

Bioaerosol testing was added to ASHRAE 52.2 as an optional appendix to allow standard testing for non-UV-only devices that are HVAC mounted. ASHRAE 185.1 covers bioaerosol removal/inactivation testing for UV devices. The new option within 52.2 uses the same basic techniques but allows them to be applied to devices, including filters, that are not covered by ASHRAE 185.1.

ASHRAE 52.2 Arrestance Test. ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2 defines synthetic test dust as a compounded test dust consisting of (by mass) 72% ISO *Standard* 12 103-A2 fine test dust, 23% powdered carbon, and 5% no. 7 cotton linters. A known amount of the prepared test dust is fed into the test unit at a known and controlled concentration. The amount of dust in the air leaving the test filter is determined by passing the entire airflow through a high-efficiency final filter (≥98%) downstream of the test filter and measuring the gain in filter mass. The synthetic mass **arrestance** is calculated using the masses of the dust captured on the final high-efficiency filter and the total dust fed.

Atmospheric aerosol particles range from a small fraction of a micrometre to tens of micrometres in diameter. The artificially generated dust cloud used in the ASHRAE arrestance method is considerably coarser than typical atmospheric dust. It tests the ability of a filter to remove the largest atmospheric aerosol particles and gives little indication of filter performance in removing the smallest particles. However, where the mass of dust in the air is the primary concern, this is a valid test because most of the mass is contained in the larger particles. Where extremely small particles (such as respirable sizes) are involved, arrestance rating does not differentiate between filters. Arrestance test results are nly used in MERV determination for MERV 1 to 4; for these filters, the arrestance is the only metric beyond the determination that an E3 based on the clean filter data is less than 20%.

ASHRAE 52.2 Dust-Holding Capacity (DHC) Test. Synthetic test dust (as described in the preceding section) is fed to the filter in accordance with ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2 procedures. The pressure drop across the filter (its resistance to airflow) rises as dust is fed. The test normally ends when resistance reaches the maximum operating resistance set by the manufacturer. However, not all filters of the same type retain collected dust equally well. The test, therefore, requires that arrestance be measured at least four times during dust loading and that the test be terminated when two consecutive arrestance values of less than 85%, or one value equal to or less than 75% of the maximum arrestance, have been measured. The ASHRAE **dust-holding capacity** is, then, the integrated amount of dust held by the filter up to the time the dust-loading test is terminated. (See ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2 for more detail.)

ISO *Standard* 16890. ISO 16890, Air Filters for General Ventilation, is a set of standards added to the general ventilation test method arsenal in 2016. It has replaced EN 779 wherever it was specified. This standard uses a similar test procedure to ASHRAE 52.2, but uses an isopropyl alcohol vapor discharge method and includes a unique rating system that relates the measured filter performance to typical urban and rural air pollution conditions. The result is a removal efficiency specified in terms of particulate matter (PM) and shown as ePM. As an example, a filter with rated performance of ISO $ePM_{2.5}$ 75% removes 75% of particles that are 2.5 microns in size or less, as measured by the standard.

This international filtration standard is split into four parts:

- Part 1: Technical specifications, requirements and classification system based upon particulate matter efficiency (ePM)
- Part 2: Measurement of fractional efficiency and air flow resistance
- Part 3: Determination of the gravimetric efficiency and the air flow resistance versus the mass of test dust captured
- Part 4: Conditioning method to determine the minimum fractional test efficiency

EN 779 (Now Replaced by ISO 16890 between 2016 and 2018). CEN developed EN *Standard* 779, Particulate Air Filters for General Ventilation—Requirements, Testing, Marking, in 1993. Its last revision, Particulate Air Filters for General Ventilation—Determination of the Filtration Performance, was approved and published in 2012. Efficiency is reported as an average efficiency after loading with ASHRAE dust. In this latest revision, minimum efficiency requirements for discharged filters are 35% for F7, 55% for F8, and 70% for F9. This is 0.4 mm efficiency, measured on media samples after discharge in liquid isopropyl alcohol (IPA). The test aerosol as specified in the standard is DEHS.

HEPA and ULPA Testing

Penetration Tests. For high-efficiency filters of the type used in cleanrooms and nuclear applications (HEPA or ULPA filters), there are several tests that may be specified, depending on end use. These tests rely on the use of oil-based test aerosols or polystyrene latex spheres (PSL) to challenge the filter.

These tests measure penetration of the test aerosol through the filter under test. The aerosol cloud is fed to the filter, which is held in a special test fixture. Any aerosol that penetrates the body of the filter or leaks through gasket cracks passes into the region downstream from the filter, where it is thoroughly mixed. Air leaving the fixture thus contains the average concentration of penetrating smoke. This concentration, as well as the upstream concentration, is measured by a light-scattering photometer.

Filter penetration *P* (%) is given as

$$P = 100\left(\frac{\text{Downstream concentration}}{\text{Upstream concentration}}\right) \quad (1)$$

Penetration, not efficiency, is usually specified in the test procedure because HEPA filters have efficiencies so near 100% (e.g., 99.97% or 99.99% on 0.30 μm particles). Penetration and efficiency E are related by the equation $E = 100 - P$. For example, a filter penetration of 0.03% can be displayed as having a filter efficiency of 99.97%.

Penetration tests are highly dependent upon three factors:

- **Aerosol Types.** DOP (dioctyl phthalate or bis-[2-ethylhexyl] phthalate) was the original test aerosol as specified by U.S. Military Standard MIL-STD-282, but this aerosol has been replaced by DEHS (di-ethyl-hexyl-sebacate) or PAO (polyalphaolefin, PAO Emery 3004) or equivalents. Polystyrene latex spheres (PSL) are solid aerosols that can be made to a specified size.
- **Particle Size.** Every filter has a most penetrating particle size (MPPS) that is aerosol and velocity dependent, and dependent upon the filter design and filter media in use. Some tests will specify a certain particle size to test, such as 0.1 or 0.3 μm, or they will use MPPS as the particle size to calculate efficiency.
- **Test Velocity.** In general, the lower the velocity that a filter is tested at will improve its filtration efficiency. It is easier for a filter to capture very small particles at slower speeds.

MIL-STD-282. Military *Standard* MIL-STD-282 (Revision B, December 22, 2015) and U.S. Army document 136-300-175A (1965) (replaced by Carlon and Guelta 1992) was first approved in 1956, specifying the use of DOP (dioctyl phthalate, also known as bis-[2-ethylhexyl] phthalate) as the test aerosol. DOP is an oily liquid with a high boiling point. In this method, a smoke cloud of DOP droplets condenses from DOP vapor.

The count median diameter for DOP aerosols is about 0.18 μm, and the mass median diameter is about 0.27 μm with a cloud concentration of approximately 20 to 80 mg/m^3 under properly controlled conditions. The procedure is sensitive to the mass median diameter, and DOP test results are commonly referred to as efficiency at 0.30 μm particle size. This penetration diameter is, of course, velocity dependent.

The DOP smoke cloud is fed to the filter, which is held in a special test fixture. Any smoke that penetrates the body of the filter or leaks through gasket cracks passes into the region downstream from the filter, where it is thoroughly mixed. Air leaving the fixture thus contains the average concentration of penetrating smoke. This concentration, as well as the upstream concentration, is measured by a light-scattering photometer.

IEST *Recommended Practices* RP-CC 001.6 and RP-CC 007.3. The Institute of Environmental Sciences and Technology has published two recommended practices: IEST RP-CC 001.6, HEPA and ULPA Filters, and IEST RP-CC 007.3, Testing ULPA Filters.

ISO 29463. ISO 29463, parts 2 to 5, have replaced EN 1822, parts 2 to 5, for the method of test for very high efficiency filters. EN-1822 part 1 remains for the classification of filters. This standard uses DEHS, PAO, or PSLs to determine filter efficiency at MPPS.

European Standard EN 1822 (Now Replaced by ISO 29463). Introduced in 1998, the EN 1822 filter standard was the first European standard to translate filtration knowledge into a classification system for HEPA filters. This test used DEHS aerosol to determine filter efficiency at MPPS. This standard has been replaced by ISO 19463.

Leakage (Scan) Tests

For HEPA filters, leakage tests are sometimes desirable to show that no small "pinhole" leaks exist or to locate any that may exist so they may be patched. Essentially, this is the same technique as used in the oil aerosol (DOP) penetration test, except that the downstream concentration is measured by scanning the face of the filter and its gasketed perimeter with a moving isokinetic sampling probe. The exact point of smoke penetration can then be located and repaired. This same test (described in IEST RP-CC 001.6) can be performed after the filter is installed. Smoke produced by a portable generator is not uniform in size, but its average diameter can be approximated as 0.6 μm. Particle diameter is less critical for leak location than for penetration measurement. The leak scan test is typically done for filters with 99.99% or higher efficiencies, in applications for which locating and repairing a discrete leak are more important.

In-Situ Testing

ISO 29462. In 2008, ASHRAE published *Guideline* 26 to provide a test method for evaluating filters in place in building HVAC systems. This guideline was adopted without technical change by the ISO and published as ISO *Standard* 29462-2013. Subsequently, ASHRAE decided to withdraw *Guideline* 26.

ISO 29462 presents a method for determining the in-place efficiency of individual particle filters or filter systems installed in building HVAC systems, as long as the filter or system is amenable to testing (e.g., enough space in the HVAC system to install sensors, well-sealed doors, etc.; a checklist is provided). Using a particle counter, particles in several size ranges between 0.3 and 5 μm that are circulating in the HVAC system are measured several times upstream and downstream of the filter to provide statistically robust data. Then, the removal efficiency is calculated by particle size. Pressure drop across the filter, temperature, and relative humidity are

recorded. The test method is theoretically applicable to all filters in HVAC systems. However, it is unlikely to yield statistically significant results for filters with efficiencies lower than MERV 11 because of the size distribution of particles typically found in building HVAC systems.

Note that field data generally show larger uncertainties than measurements made in a laboratory. For filter/filter system tests, this is because of the variety of different HVAC environments and particle types likely to be encountered, and the difficulties in controlling environmental variables during the test. ISO 29462 includes a procedure for reducing uncertainty by subjecting a reference filter to measurement both in the field and in a laboratory.

Respirator Tests

Test standards have been developed in the United States for respirator air filters to receive NIOSH approvals, covered under 42 CFR Part 84. These standards rate respirators as oilproof (P), oil-resistant (R), or not oilproof (N), along with an efficiency rating such as N95.

Environmental Tests

Air cleaners may be subjected to fire, high humidity, a wide range of temperatures, mechanical shock, vibration, and other environmental stress. Several standardized tests exist for evaluating these environmental effects on air cleaners. U.S. Military Standard MIL-STD-282 includes shock tests (shipment rough handling) and filter media water-resistance tests. Several U.S. Atomic Energy Commission agencies (now part of the U.S. Department of Energy) specify humidity and temperature-resistance tests (DOE 1997, 2003).

UL *Standard* 900. This destructive test procedure measures the amount of flame, smoke, or both generated by a filter when subjected to a burner in a test duct. Additionally, to pass, a filter must not generate sparks beyond the discharge length of the test duct.

This procedure does not consider filter performance regarding particle collection at any point of its test life, and pertains to a clean filter only. As filters accumulate particles, the burning, smoke, and spark characteristics change based on the contaminant in the media; thus, UL *Standard* 900 applies *only* to new filters. Once a filter has been put in service, the classification is no longer valid.

UL *Standard* 586. This test was specifically designed to evaluate the performance of a HEPA filter in extreme and rigorous conditions. While being particle challenged, the filter is subjected to extreme cold, heat, and humidity. In addition, there are shock tests simulating shipping and handling stresses to evaluate physical durability, and a flame test on the media. The standard also has some specific construction requirements for various portions of each element.

In 1991, UL *Standard* 586 was required by the Department of Defense for Nuclear material applications. It is an integral part of ASME *Standard* AG-1, Code on Nuclear Air and Gas Treatment.

The UL tests do not evaluate the effect of collected dust on filter flammability; depending on the dust, this effect may be severe. UL *Standard* 867 applies to electronic air cleaners. UL 2998 covers ozone emissions from air cleaners. The standard test is done in a chamber, but there is an option for a single-pass test.

AHRI Standards

The Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute published AHRI *Standards* 680 (residential) and 850 (commercial/industrial) for air filter equipment. *Standard* 680 applies to both media and electronic air cleaners, and specifies rating conditions for performance, capacity, and restriction. These standards establish (1) definitions and classification; (2) requirements for testing and rating; (3) specification of standard equipment; (4) performance and safety requirements; (5) proper marking; (6) conformance conditions; and (7) literature and advertising requirements. However, certification of air cleaners is not a part of these standards.

AHAM Standards

Particulate removal air cleaners may also be non-HVAC mounted. In-room air cleaners sometimes include filters that are tested per ASHRAE 52.2 or HEPA standards, but these air cleaners in their entirety are tested per the American Household Appliance Manufactures (AHAM) chamber test. In-room air cleaners and associated standards created by AHAM are discussed in more detail in Chapter 66 in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

8. SELECTION AND MAINTENANCE

In addition to criteria affecting the degree of air cleanliness, factors such as cost (initial investment, maintenance, and energy effectiveness), space requirements, and airflow resistance have led to the development of a wide variety of air cleaners. Comparisons of different air cleaners can be made from data obtained by standardized test methods.

To evaluate filters and air cleaners properly for a particular application, consider the following factors:

- Types of contaminants present indoors and outdoors
- Sizes and concentrations of contaminants
- Source type, including whether constant or intermittent
- Air cleanliness levels required in the space
- Air filter efficiency needed to achieve cleanliness
- Space available to install and access equipment
- Life-cycle costing, including
  - Operating resistance to airflow (static pressure differential) for HVAC; final resistance to airflow as well as clean-device resistance should be compatible with the fans and other resistance in an HVAC system
  - Power consumption for in-room air cleaners
  - Disposal or cleaning requirements of spent filters/parts
  - Initial cost of selected system
  - Cost of replacement filters or cleaning
  - Cost of warehousing filter stock and change-out labor

Savings (from reduced housekeeping expenses, protection of valuable property and equipment, dust-free environments for manufacturing processes, improved working conditions, and even health benefits) should be credited against the cost of installing and operating an adequate system. The capacity and physical size of the required unit may emphasize the need for low maintenance cost. Operating cost, predicted life, and efficiency are as important as initial cost because air cleaning is a continuing process.

Panel filters do not have efficiencies as high as can be expected from extended-surface filters, but their initial cost and upkeep are generally low. Compared to moving-curtain filters, panel filters of comparable efficiencies require more attention to maintain the resistance within reasonable limits. However, single-stage, face- or side-access, low- to medium-efficiency filters of MERV 6 to 10 from a 50 mm pleat to a 300 mm deep cube, bag, or deep pleated cartridge, require less space with lower initial cost, and have better efficiency. The bag and cartridges generally have a similar service life to that of a roll filter.

If efficiency of MERV 11 or higher is required, extended-surface filters or electronic air cleaners should be considered. The use of very fine glass fiber mats or other materials in extended-surface filters has made these available at the highest efficiency.

Initial cost of an extended-surface filter is lower than for an electronic unit, but higher than for a panel type. Operating and maintenance costs of some extended-surface filters may be higher than for panel types and electronic air cleaners, but efficiencies are always higher than for panel types; the cost/benefit ratio must be considered. Pressure drop of media-type filters is greater than that of electronic types, and slowly increases during their useful life. Advantages include the fact that no mechanical or electrical ser-

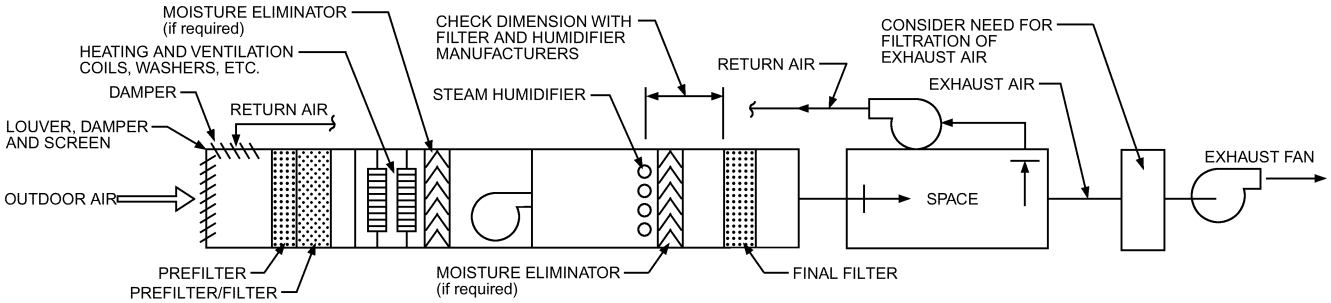

Fig. 5 Typical Filter Locations for HVAC System

vices are required. Choice should be based on both initial and operating costs (life-cycle costs), as well as on the degree of cleaning efficiency and maintenance requirements.

Although electronic air cleaners have higher initial and maintenance costs, they have high initial efficiencies in cleaning atmospheric air, largely because of their ability to remove fine particulate contaminants. System resistance remains unchanged as particles are collected, and efficiency is reduced until the resulting residue is removed from the collection plates to prepare the equipment for further duty. The manufacturer must supply information on maintenance or cleaning. Also, note that electronic air cleaners may not collect particles greater than 10 μm in diameter.

Figure 5 shows where filtration can be placed in an HVAC system. Each area indicates the point of potential need for particulate removal.

The typical contaminants listed in Table 3 appear in the general reporting group that removes the smallest known size of that specific contaminant. The order in which they are listed has no significance, and the list is not complete. The typical applications and typical air cleaners listed are intended to show where and what type of air cleaner could be and/or has been traditionally used. Traditional usage may not represent the optimum choice, so using the table as a selection guide is not appropriate when a specific performance requirement is needed. An air cleaner application specialist should then be consulted and manufacturers' performance curves should be reviewed.

Note that MERV 17 to 20, which were shown in early versions of ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2 to give readers a feeling for where HEPAs could be considered to fit into the MERV scale, were removed because of the confusion when readers assumed these theoretical MERV values existed and tried to use ASHRAE testing procedures for them. ASHRAE 52.2 does not test to these filter levels. For HEPA filters, refer to the ISO or IEST classification system (IEST 2007, 2009; ISO 2012).

Common sense and some knowledge of how air cleaners work help the user achieve satisfactory results. Air cleaner performance varies from the time it is first installed until the end of its service life. Generally, the longer a media-type filter is in service, the higher the efficiency. The accumulation of contaminants begins to close the porous openings, and, therefore, the filter is able to intercept smaller particles. However, there are exceptions that vary with different styles of media-type filters. Electronic air cleaners and charged-fiber media filters start at high efficiency when new (or after proper service, in the case of electronic air cleaners), but their efficiency decreases as contaminants accumulate. Charged media filters may drop as much as 50% of the initial efficiency, especially at lower particle sizes, unless the drop-off effect is countered by significant collection of larger particles and buildup of filter cake to add in collection. Some air cleaners, particularly low-efficiency devices, may begin to shed some collected contaminants after being in service. Testing with standardized synthetic loading dust attempts to predict this, but such testing rarely, if ever, duplicates the air cleaner's performance on atmospheric dust.

The loading rate of all filters depends on the type and concentration of particles in the air being handled and the operating cycle of the system. Media filters may be monitored for resistance to airflow and changed when a predetermined level is reached to minimize filter costs, or they may be changed on a time-based schedule for ease of scheduling. Life-cycle cost (LCC), including energy necessary to overcome the filter resistance (which will vary by fan and other resistance in the HVAC system), should be calculated to evaluate the overall cost of the filtering system.

Residential Air Cleaners

Panel air filters with a MERV 7 or lower, traditionally used for residential applications, may be of spun glass and only filter out the largest of particles. These filters may prevent damage to downstream equipment, but they do little to improve air quality in the residence. MERV 8 or better filters are now recommended. To use higher-MERV filters in residential applications, it is important to be sure the system can handle the pressure drop. If space exists, deeper filters may help reduce pressure drop while increasing the efficiency (and MERV) of filters. Residential architects and contractors should consider providing deeper filter banks (50 to 150 mm during new construction and renovations to allow homeowners greater flexibility in choosing higher-MERV filtration.

In addition to particle removal efficiency, system runtime has a large impact on the effectiveness of air cleaners used in central residential forced-air heating and cooling systems. These systems typically operate only in response to demands for heating or cooling. ASHRAE RP-1691 used building energy modeling combined with an indoor air mass balance model to predict the impacts of various MERV filters on reducing indoor concentrations of $PM_{2.5}$ and UFPs of outdoor origin. Azimi et al. (2016) estimated that low system runtimes mean that even the highest levels of filtration efficiency cannot achieve more than ~50% particle removal in the space, and that effectiveness depends strongly on home vintage, climate zone, and ventilation strategy. Touchie and Siegel (2018) analyzed central residential system runtime data from over 7000 homes in North America and found that the median system runtime was only 18%, with considerable variation between homes. Moreover, at low to average runtimes, it was noted that effectiveness of the filter matters much less because the system does not run enough for a sufficient air volume to pass through the filter and have a substantial impact on particle concentrations. Increasing runtimes (e.g., by operating systems in fan-only mode continuously or for great cycle lengths) can improve filtration effectiveness but will come with an additional energy cost.

VAV Systems

ASHRAE tests on numerous different media-type air cleaners under both constant and variable airflow showed no significant performance differences under different flow conditions, and the air

Table 3 Application Guidelines for MERV Filters

Std. 52.2 Minimum Efficiency Reporting Value (MERV)	Typical Controlled Contaminant	Typical Applications and Limitations	Typical Air Filter/Cleaner Type
16	0.30 to 1.0 µm Particle Size	Hospital inpatient care	**Bag Filters**
	All bacteria	General surgery	Nonsupported (flexible) microfine fiberglass or synthetic media. 300
15	Most tobacco smoke	Smoking lounges	to 900 mm (12 to 36 in.) deep, 6 to 12 pockets.
	Droplet nuclei (sneeze)	Superior commercial	**Box Filters**
14	Cooking oil	buildings	Rigid style cartridge filters 150 to 300 mm
	Most smoke		(6 to 12 in.) deep may use lofted (air laid) or paper (wet laid) media.
13	Insecticide dust		
	Copier toner		
	Most face powder		
	Most paint pigments		
12	1.0 to 3.0 µm Particle Size	Superior residential	Bag Filters
	Legionella	Better commercial	Nonsupported (flexible) microfine fiberglass or synthetic media. 300
11	Humidifier dust	buildings	to 900 mm (12 to 36 in.) deep, 6 to 12 pockets.
	Lead dust	Hospital laboratories	Box Filters
10	Milled flour		Rigid style cartridge filters 150 to 300 mm
	Coal dust		(6 to 12 in.) deep may use lofted (air laid) or paper (wet laid) media.
9	Auto emissions		
	Nebulizer drops		
	Welding fumes		
8	3.0 to 10.0 µm Particle Size	Commercial buildings	Pleated Filters
	Mold	Better residential	Disposable, extended surface, 25 to 125 mm
7	Spores	Industrial workplaces	(1 to 5 in.) thick with cotton-polyester blend media, cardboard frame.
	Hair spray	Paint booth inlet air	Cartridge Filters
6	Fabric protector		Graded density viscous coated cube or pocket filters, synthetic
	Dusting aids		media.
5	Cement dust		Throwaway
	Pudding mix		Disposable synthetic media panel filters.
	Snuff		
	Powdered milk		
4	**>10.0 µm Particle Size**	Minimum filtration	Throwaway
	Pollen	Residential	Disposable fiberglass or synthetic panel filters
3	Spanish moss	Window air conditioners	Washable
	Dust mites		Aluminum mesh, latex coated animal hair, or foam rubber panel
2	Sanding dust		filters
	Spray paint dust		Electrostatic
1	Textile fibers		Self charging (passive) woven polycarbonate
	Carpet fibers		panel filter

Note: A MERV for other than HEPA/ULPA filters also includes a test airflow rate, but it is not shown here because it has no significance for the purposes of this table.

cleaners were not damaged by VAV flow. Low-efficiency air cleaners did show substantial reentrainment for both constant and VAV flow (Rivers and Murphy 2000).

Antimicrobial Treatment of Filter Media

Several varieties and all efficiencies of filters have been treated with antimicrobial additives. The key performance goal is to reduce the growth of microbial organisms in filter components (e.g., the media itself, separators in high-efficiency minipleats, framing components). The intent is not to make the air clean and free of viable microbes, but rather to prevent filter components from becoming the microbial reservoir.

An ASHRAE-funded research project tested low-efficiency filters for microbial reduction for both initial and loaded conditions (Foarde et al. 2000). Under normal use, fibrous air cleaners were found to be unlikely to become a source of microbial contamination to the space, and antimicrobial treatment usually did not increase the filtration efficiency for bioaerosols. The dust cake was found to mask the antimicrobial eliminating contact with the bioaerosols. In the United States, EPA guidelines must be met for the antimicrobial product to be used in air filters.

Maintenance

Various cleaning methods have been recommended for permanent media filters; the most widely used involves washing the filter with steam or water (frequently with detergent).

If maintained properly by regular cleaning, including wiping the wires, ESPs have relatively constant pressure drop and efficiency. If they are not cleaned regularly, dendritic buildup on the wires can reduce the efficiency or the unit and may lead to sparking. Accumulated dust can build up to the point that arcing may occur in the collection section of the air cleaner. This may reduce the collection efficiency, as well as produce unwanted extraneous noise. Dust buildup in the ionizer section can also reduce efficiency.

Plate-type air cleaner cells must be cleaned periodically with detergent and hot water. Some designs incorporate automatic wash systems that clean the cells in place; in others, the cells are re-moved for cleaning. The frequency of cleaning (washing) the cell depends

on the contaminant and the concentration. Industrial applications may require cleaning every 8 h, but a residential unit may only require cleaning every one to three months. The timing of the cleaning schedule is important to keep the unit performing at peak efficiency. For some contaminants, special attention must be given to cleaning the ionizing wires. The air cleaner must be maintained based on the recommendations of the manufacturer.

Electrically enhanced air cleaners have a longer service life between maintenance than plate-type precipitators. Maintenance consists of replacing the filter and cleaning the ionizing section and prefilter.

9. AIR CLEANER INSTALLATION

An air filter must fit into the duct or frame it is installed into, and it must be sealed in to achieve the expected performance. Thus, the size of the filter and method of installation are both critical for particle removal to be achieved. Many air cleaners are available in units of convenient size for manual installation, cleaning, and replacement. A typical unit filter may be a 400 to 650 mm square or rectangle, from 25 to 400 mm in depth, and of either the dry or viscous impingement type. In large systems, the frames in which these units are installed are bolted or riveted together to form a filter bank. Automatic filters are constructed in sections offering several choices of width up to 20 m and generally range in height from 1 to 5 m, in 100 to 150 mm increments. Several sections may be bolted together to form a filter bank.

Several manufacturers provide side-loading access filter sections for various types of filters. Filters are changed from outside the duct, making service areas in the duct unnecessary, thus saving cost and space.

Of course, in-service efficiency of an air filter is sharply reduced if air leaks through the bypass dampers or poorly designed filter-holding frames. Filters must be sealed in so that all the air goes through the filter; bypass will result in lower removal efficiency due to the untreated air. The higher the filter efficiency, the more careful attention must be paid to the rigidity and sealing effectiveness of the frame. For example, a 10% bypass for a 40% efficient filter only results in a 4% loss in removal, whereas an 80% efficiency filter with the same 10% bypass results in 20% less removal. Sealing may be achieved by a simple clamp, pressing into a gasket, a tight fit in a holder, or use of a sealant. In addition, high-efficiency filters must be handled and installed with care. The National Air Filtration Association (NAFA 2006) suggests some precautions needed for HEPA filters.

Air cleaners may be installed in the outdoor-air intake ducts of buildings and residences and in the recirculation and bypass air ducts; however, the prefilters (in a two- or three-stage system) should be placed upstream of heating or cooling coils and other air-conditioning equipment in the system to protect that equipment from dust. Dust in commercial buildings where outdoor air is brought in is likely to be predominantly alumniosilicates, whereas dander is likely to predominate in solely recirculated air such as in residences (Owen et al. 2014). Where high-efficiency filters protect critical areas such as cleanrooms, it is important that filters be installed as close to the room as possible to prevent pickup of particles between the filters and the outlet. The ultimate installation is the unidirectional flow room, in which the entire ceiling or one entire wall becomes the final filter bank.

Although published performance data for all air filters are based on straight-through unrestricted airflow perpendicular to the frame, V-bank designs with 30 to 60° angles are common in commercial applications. Cooling coils are often designed with face velocities not to exceed 2.5 m/s, and filter banks are often specified at lower face velocities such as 1.8 m/s. The use of V-banks allows AHU manufacturers to accommodate such designs while maintaining consistent height and width of adjacent AHU sections. Care should be taken to ensure filters receive even air distribution. Uneven air distribution leads to uneven loading of filters. When filters become unevenly loaded, more air flows through the cleaner areas of the filter, and the higher velocities through the clean areas decrease filter performance.

Failure of air filter installations to give satisfactory results can, in most cases, be traced to faulty installation, improper maintenance, or both. The most important requirements of a satisfactory and efficiently operating air filter installation are as follows:

- The filter must be of ample capacity for the amount of air and dust load it is expected to handle. An overload of 10 to 15% is regarded as the maximum allowable. When air volume is subject to future increase, a larger filter bank should be installed initially.
- The filter must be suited to the operating conditions, such as degree of air cleanliness required, amount of dust in the entering air, type of duty, allowable pressure drop, operating temperature, and maintenance facilities. Where UV lamps are also used, filters of some materials should not be directly irradiated because it may degrade the filter; check with the filter and UV company to determine compatibility.

The following recommendations apply to filters installed with central fan systems:

- Duct connections to and from the filter should change size or shape gradually to ensure even air distribution over the entire filter area. SMACNA standards should be followed for all elbows, junctions, and transitions upstream of the filter bank.

  When installing electrostatic precipitators, duct approaches to and from the air cleaner housing should be arranged so that airflow is distributed uniformly over the face area. Panel prefilters should also be used to help distribute airflow and to trap large particles that might short out or cause excessive arcing in the high-voltage section of the air cleaner cell. Design parameters of air velocity, ionizer field strength, cell plate spacing, depth, and plate voltage must match the application requirements (e.g., contaminant type, particle size, volume of air, required efficiency). Many units are designed for installation into central heating and cooling systems for total air filtration. Other self-contained units are furnished complete with air movers for source control of contaminants in specific applications that need an independent air cleaner.
- Locate the filter far enough from the fan to prevent or reduce reentrainment of particles, especially during start/stop cycles.
- Provide sufficient space in front of (upstream) or behind (downstream of) the filter, or both, depending on its type, to make it accessible for inspection and service. A distance of 500 to 1000 mm is required, depending on the filter chosen.
- Provide conveniently sized access doors to the filter service areas.
- All doors on the clean-air side should be gasketed to prevent infiltration of unclean air. All connections and seams of the sheet-metal ducts on the clean-air side should be airtight. The filter bank must be caulked to prevent bypass of unfiltered air, especially when high-efficiency filters are used.
- Lights should be permanently installed in access sections where personnel are required to enter the AHU for filter replacements and inspections.
- Filters installed close to an outdoor air inlet should be protected from the weather by suitable louvers or an inlet hood.
- In areas with extreme rainfall or where water can drip over or bounce (travel) up in front of the inlet, use drainable track moisture separator sections upstream of the first filter bank. Place a large-mesh wire bird screen in front of the louvers or in the hood. In areas with snowfall potential, care should be taken to ensure that the maximum snow drift accumulation against the exterior

wall does not exceed the height of the outdoor air inlet, because snow may melt and damage filter.
- Filters, other than electronic air cleaners, should consider having permanent indicators (airflow resistance gage) to give notice when the filter reaches its final pressure drop or is exhausted, as with automatic roll media filters. Where pressure drop indicators are not feasible to determine replacement times for filters, a filter replacement schedule shall be established to ensure that filters do not remain in service beyond their loading capabilities.
- Electronic air cleaners should have an indicator or alarm to indicate when high voltage is off or shorted out.

When filters are exposed to UV lighting, filtration media and housing shall be fabricated with UV resistant materials.

Filter Sealing And Installation Techniques

Gasket Seal. The gasket is applied to either the upstream or downstream flange. The gasket is compressed between an opposing mating surface of housing or filter fixing grid.

Gel Seal. The filter frame is provided with an integral gel channel that is filled with a low-outgassing polyurethane-based gel (ISPE 2019). The gel interfaces with an opposing knife edge integral to the housing or filter fixing grid. The gel penetrating knife edge creates a positive seal between the housing and the filters. This technique is most often used in bottom-loading or room side replaceable applications.

Knife Edge Seal. In this case, the filter frame is produced with integral knife edge. The knife edge interfaces with a gel channel that is integral to the housing or filter fixing grid. This technique is preferred in common plenum applications where the weight of the filter and pressure from airflow create a positive seal. No mounting hardware should be required.

10. SAFETY CONSIDERATIONS

Safety ordinances should be investigated when the installation of an air cleaner is contemplated (UL, AFI, NIST). Combustible filtering media may not be allowed by some local regulations. Combustion of dust and lint on filtering media is possible, although the media itself may not burn. This may cause a substantial increase in filter combustibility. Smoke detectors and fire sprinkler systems should be considered for filter bank locations. In some cases, depending on the contaminant, hazardous material procedures must be followed during removal and disposal of the used filter. Bag-in/bag-out (BI/BO) filter housings should be seriously considered in those cases.

Many air filters are efficient collectors of bioaerosols. When provided with moisture and nutrients, the microorganisms can multiply and may become a health hazard for maintenance personnel and building occupants. Moisture in filters can be minimized by preventing (1) entrance of rain, snow, and fog; (2) carryover of water droplets from coils, drain pans, and humidifiers; and (3) prolonged exposure to elevated humidity. Changing or cleaning filters regularly is important for controlling microbial growth.

Good health-safety practices for personnel handling dirty filters include wearing personal protective equipment (PPE), which includes a face mask, nitrile gloves, shoe covers, and safety glasses; and thorough washing upon completion. Old filters should be placed in plastic bags or other containers for safe disposal. Be careful not to shake or drop it, as particles can be released into the air by any sudden movements. Tie and tape the bag shut.

All high-voltage devices (such as electrostatic precipitators) can produce ozone, which is toxic and damaging not only to human lungs, but to paper, rubber, and other materials. When properly designed and maintained, an electronic air cleaner produces an ozone concentration that only reaches a fraction of the limit acceptable for continuous human exposure and is less than that prevalent in many American cities (EPA 1996). Continuous arcing and brush discharge in an electrostatic precipitator may yield an ozone level that is annoying or mildly toxic; this is indicated by a strong ozone odor. Although the nose is sensitive to ozone, only actual measurement of the concentration can determine whether a hazardous condition exists.

It is recommended to use ozone-producing devices that have a certification such as UL 867 or UL 2998 to avoid developing concentrations in excess of the NIOSH Regular Exposure Limit of 100 ppb (or lower if required by a local authority having jurisdiction or other site specific requirements). Real-time ozone monitoring should be used for all equipment not meeting the requirements of UL 2998.

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CHAPTER 30

AIR POLLUTION CONTROL AND INDUSTRIAL PROCESS CLEANING

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AIR pollution control and industrial process cleaning perform one or more of the following functions:

- Maintains compliance of an industrial process with the laws or regulations for air pollution
- Reduces nuisance or physical damage from contaminants to individuals, equipment, products, or adjacent properties
- Prepares cleaned gases and airstreams for processes
- Reclaims usable materials, heat, or energy
- Reduces fire, explosion, or other hazards

Equipment that removes particulate matter from a gas stream may also remove or create some gaseous contaminants; on the other hand, equipment that is primarily intended for removal of gaseous pollutants might also remove or create objectionable particulate matter to some degree. In all cases, air pollution control gas-cleaning equipment changes the process stream, and it is therefore essential that the engineer evaluate the consequences of those changes to the plant's overall operation.

Equipment Selection

In selecting air pollution control equipment, plant operations and the use or disposal of materials captured by the gas-cleaning equipment must be considered. Because the cost and efficiency of air pollution control equipment affects manufacturing costs, alternative processes should be evaluated early to minimize the effect equipment may have on the total cost of a product and manufacturing operations. An alternative manufacturing process may reduce the cost of or eliminate the need for gas-cleaning equipment. However, even when gas-cleaning equipment is required, process and system control should minimize load on the collection device.

An industrial process may be changed from dirty to clean by substituting a process material (e.g., switching to a cleaner-burning fuel or pretreating the existing fuel). Equipment redesign, such as enclosing pneumatic conveyors or recycling noncondensable gases, may also clean the process. Occasionally, additives (e.g., chemical dust suppressants used in quarrying or liquid animal fat applied to dehydrated alfalfa before grinding) reduce the potential for air pollution or concentrate the pollutants so that a smaller, more concentrated process stream may be treated.

Gas streams containing contaminants should not usually be diluted with extraneous air unless the extra air is required for cooling or to condense contaminants to make them collectible. The volume of gas to be cleaned is a major factor in the owning and operating costs of control equipment. Therefore, source capture ventilation, where contaminants are kept concentrated in relatively small volumes of air, is generally preferable to general ventilation, where pollutants are allowed to mix into and be diluted by much of the air in a plant space. Chapters 32 and 33 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* address local and general ventilation of industrial environments. Regulatory authorities generally require the levels of emissions to be corrected to standard conditions taking into account temperature, pressure, moisture content, and factors related to combustion or production rate. However, the air-cleaning equipment must be designed using the actual conditions of the process stream as it will enter the equipment.

In this chapter, each generic type of equipment is discussed on the basis of its primary method for gas or particulate abatement. The development of systems that incorporate several of the devices discussed here for specific industrial processes is left to the engineer.

1. REGULATIONS AND STANDARDS

Gas-Cleaning Regulations and Codes

In 1960, only six U.S. states had air pollution programs. By 1970, all 50 states did. This shift occurred due to increased public interest and pressure on legislators to address dense, visible smog in many of the nation's cities, and the health issues thus caused. The Clean Air Act of 1963 was the first federal legislation concerning air pollution control. The Clean Air Amendments of 1970 (CAA 1970) built on and expanded the original legislation's scope, allowing for development of federal and state regulations to protect public health and the environment by limiting emissions from both stationary (industrial) and mobile (vehicle) sources. Most notably, CAA (1970) established the National Ambient Air Quality Standards (NAAQS), National Emissions Standards for Hazardous Air Pollutants (NESHAPs), and New Source Performance Standards (NSPS). During this time, a new Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) was established to consolidate the federal government's many environmental responsibilities under one agency and implement the requirements of the new legislation.

Today, in the United States, industrial gas-cleaning installations that exhaust to the outdoor environment are regulated by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA); those that exhaust to the workplace are regulated by the Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) of the U.S. Department of Labor (DoL). The Mine Safety and Health Administration (MSHA) is also a DoL agency, and solely regulates the mining industry, including underground mines, quarries, and other surface mining sites. Both OSHA

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and MSHA have recently published new regulations on silica dusts in the workplace.

The EPA has established Standards of Performance for New Stationary Sources (New Source Performance Standards [NSPSs, GPO) and more restrictive State Implementation Plans (SIP 1991) and local codes as a regulatory basis to achieve air quality standards. Information on the current status of the NSPSs can be obtained through the Semi-Annual Regulatory Agenda, as published in the Federal Register, and through the regional offices of the EPA.

AP-42, Compilation of Air Pollutant Emissions Factors, has been published since 1972 as the primary compilation of the EPA's emissions factor information. It contains emissions factors and process information for more than 200 air pollution source categories (i.e., specific industry sectors or groups of similar emitting sources). The emissions factors were developed and compiled from source test data, material balance studies, and engineering estimates.

The fifth edition of AP-42 was published in January 1995. Supplements and updates are available in volume I, Stationary Point and Area Sources, and on the EPA web site. Additional design information for gas-cleaning equipment can be found in Buonicore and Davis (1992) and Sink (1991).

Where air is not affected by combustion, solvent vapors, and toxic materials, it may be desirable to recirculate the air to the workplace to reduce energy costs or to balance static pressure in a building. High-efficiency fabric or cartridge filters, precipitators, or special-purpose wet scrubbers are typically used in general ventilation systems to reduce particle concentrations to levels acceptable for recirculated air.

The Industrial Ventilation Committee of the American Conference of Governmental Industrial Hygienists (ACGIH) and the National Institute of Occupational Safety and Health (NIOSH) have established criteria for recirculation of cleaned process air to the work area (ACGIH 2010; NIOSH 1978). Fine-particle control by various dust collectors under recirculating airflows has been investigated by Bergin et al. (1989).

Often there are several hazards associated with controlling combustible particulate. The National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) offers several codes and standards to help prevent and reduce dust hazards, fires, and explosions, as discussed in the section on Fires, Explosions, and Hazards. Compliance with these codes and standards can help minimize the risks of dust explosions and protect staff, equipment, and facilities from harm.

Public complaints may occur even when the effluent concentrations discharged to the atmosphere are below the maximum allows emission rates and opacity limits. Thus, in addition to codes or regulations, the plant location, the contaminants involved, and the meteorological conditions of the area must be evaluated.

In most cases, emission standards require a higher degree of gas cleaning than necessary for the economic recovery of process products (if this recovery is desirable). Gas cleanliness is a priority, especially where toxic materials are involved and cleaned gases might be recirculated to the work area.

Measuring Gas Streams and Contaminants

Stack sampling is often required to fulfill requirements of operating and installation permits for gas-cleaning devices, to establish conformance with regulations, and to commission new equipment. Also, it can be used to establish specifications for gas-cleaning equipment and to certify that the equipment is functioning properly. The tests determine the composition and quantity of gases and particulate matter at selected locations along the process stream. The following general principles apply to a stack sampling program:

- The sampling location(s) must be acceptable to all parties who will use the results.
- The sampling location(s) must meet acceptable criteria with respect to temperature, flow distribution and turbulence, and distance from disturbances to the process stream. Exceptions based on physical constraints must be identified and reported.
- Samples that are withdrawn from a duct or stack must represent typical conditions in the process stream. Proper stack traverses must be made and particulate samples withdrawn isokinetically.
- Stack sampling should be performed in accordance with approved methods and established protocols whenever possible.
- Variations in the volumetric flow, temperature, and particulate or gaseous pollutant emissions, along with upset conditions, should be identified.
- A report from stack sampling should include a summary of the process, which should identify any deviations from normal process operations that occurred during testing. The summary should be prepared during the testing phase and certified by the process owner at completion of the tests.
- Disposal methods for waste generated during testing must be identified before testing begins. This is especially critical where pilot plant equipment is being tested because new forms of waste are often produced.
- The regulatory basis for the tests should be established so that the results can be presented in terms of process mass rate, consumption of raw materials, energy use, and so forth.

Analyses of the samples can provide the following types of information about the emissions:

- Physical characteristics of the contaminant: solid dust, liquid mist or "smoke," waxy solids, or a sticky mixture of liquid and solid.
- Distribution of particle sizes: optical, physical, aerodynamic, etc.
- Concentration of particulate matter in the gases, including average and extreme values, and a profile of concentrations in the duct or stack.
- Volumetric flow of gases, including average and extreme values, and a profile of this flow in the duct or stack. The volumetric flow is commonly expressed at actual conditions and at various standard conditions of temperature, pressure, moisture, and process state.
- Chemical composition of gases and particulate matter, including recovery value, toxicity, solubility, acid dew point, etc.
- Particle and bulk densities of particulate matter.
- Handling characteristics of particulate matter, including erosive, corrosive, abrasive, agglomerative, or adhesive/cohesive qualities.
- Flammable or explosive limits.
- Electrical resistivity of deposits of particulate matter under stack and laboratory conditions. These data are useful for assessments of electrostatic precipitators and other electrostatically augmented technology.

EPA Reference Methods. The EPA has developed methods to measure the particulate and gaseous components of emissions from many industrial processes and has incorporated these in the NSPS by reference. Appendix A of the New Source Performance Standards lists the reference methods (GPO, annual). These are updated regularly in the Federal Register. Guidance for using these reference methods can be found in the *Quality Assurance Handbook for Air Pollution Measurement Systems* (EPA-454/B-17-001, January 2017).

In 2004, the EPA promulgated fine particle standards for ambient air quality. Known as PM_{10} and $PM_{2.5}$ Standards, these revised standards focus particulate abatement efforts toward the collection and control of airborne particles smaller than 10 μm and 2.5 μm, respectively. The EPA reviewed the air quality standards for particulate matter (PM) and decided, effective December 18, 2020, to keep the current standards without revision.

Currently, further reductions in allowable $PM_{2.5}$ particulate matter have been submitted for public comment in 2023 and are under

consideration. Fine particles (with aerodynamic particle size smaller than 2.5 μm) are of concern because they penetrate deeply D6830-0into the lungs. With the development of these standards, concern has arisen over the efficiency of industrial gas cleaners at various particle sizes.

Other Test Methods for Reverse-Pulse Filter Fabric Baghouses and Filter Media

ASHRAE Methods. ASHRAE Standard 199 is a testing procedure that measures how well specifically designed dust collectors perform in real-world conditions. The test provides data to compare dust collectors based on their performance data on emissions, pressure drop, compressed air usage, energy consumption, and emission readings. It involves six stages that measure the dust collector's performance for emissions, pressure drop, and compressed air usage. The test is important because it is the first laboratory test method to measure emissions, differential pressure average, and air consumption in pulse-cleaned dust collectors under realistic operating conditions.

ASTM Methods. The EPA has also approved ASTM test methods when cited in the NSPSs or the applicable EPA reference methods. ASTM *Standard* D6830 determines airflow resistance, drag, cleaning requirements, and particulate filtration performance of reverse-pulse-cleaned filter media under specified laboratory conditions. Results of this test are useful in the design, construction, selection, and performance comparison of filter media.

Other Methods. Sometimes, the reference methods must be modified, with the consent of regulatory authorities, to achieve representative sampling under the less-than-ideal conditions of industrial operations. Modifications to test methods should be clearly identified and explained in test reports.

Gas Flow Distribution

The control of gas flow through industrial gas-cleaning equipment is important for good system performance. Because of the large gas flows commonly encountered and the frequent need to retrofit equipment to existing processes, space allocations often preclude gradual expansion and long-radius turns. Instead, elbow splitters, baffles, etc., are used. These components must be designed to limit dust buildup and corrosion to acceptable levels.

2. PARTICULATE CONTAMINANT CONTROL

Particulate collectors may be evaluated for their ability to remove particulate matter from a gas stream and for their ability to reduce the emissions of selected particle sizes. The degree to which particulate matter is separated from a gas stream is known as the efficiency of a collector; the fraction of material escaping collection is the penetration. The reduction of particulate matter in a selected particle size range is known as the fractional efficiency of a particulate collector.

The **efficiency** η of a collector is generally expressed as a percent of the mass flow rate of material entering and exiting the collector.

$$\eta = 100(w_i - w_o)/w_i = 100w_c/w_i \quad (1)$$

where

η = efficiency of collector, %
w_i = mass flow rate of contaminant in gases entering collector
w_o = mass flow rate of contaminant in gases exiting collector
w_c = mass flow rate of contaminant captured by collector

Alternatively, the efficiency of a collector can be expressed in terms of the concentrations of particulate matter entering and exiting the equipment. This approach can be unsatisfactory because of changes that occur in the gas stream due to air leakage in the system, condensation, and temperature and pressure changes.

Table 1 Principal Types of Particulate Control Equipment

Gravity and momentum collectors	• Settling chambers • Louvers and baffle chambers
Centrifugal collectors	• Cyclones and multicyclones • Rotating "centrifugal" mist collectors
Electrostatic precipitators	• Tubular or plate-type, wet or dry, high-voltage (single-stage) precipitators • Plate-type, wet or dry, low-voltage (two-stage) mist and smoke precipitators
Fabric filters	• Baghouses; fabric collectors; cartridge filters • Disposable media filters (for dust and/or mist)
Mist collectors	• Fiber bed filters, panel filters, high-loft bag filters, centrifugal filters, and electrostatic precipitators (ESPs)
Particulate scrubbers	• Spray scrubbers • Impingement scrubbers • Centrifugal-type scrubbers • Orifice-type scrubbers • Venturi scrubbers • Packed towers • Mobile bed scrubbers • Electrostatically augmented scrubbers

Penetration P is usually measured, and the efficiency for a collector calculated, using the following equations:

$$P = 100w_o - w_i \quad (2)$$

with

$$\eta = 100 - P \quad (3)$$

The **fractional efficiency** of a particulate collector is determined by measuring the mass rate of contaminants entering and exiting the collector in selected particle size ranges. Methods for measuring the fractional efficiency of particulate collectors in industrial applications are only beginning to emerge, largely because of the need to compare the fine-particle performance of collectors used under the PM_{10} and $PM_{2.5}$ regulations for ambient air quality.

Measures of performance other than efficiency should also be considered in designing industrial gas-cleaning systems. Table 1 describes some of the main types of particulate control equipment, and Table 2 compares some of these factors for typical equipment. Note that this table contains only nominal values and is no substitute for experience, trade studies, and an engineering assessment of requirements for specific installations.

Table 3 summarizes the types of collectors that have been used in industrial applications.

2.1 MECHANICAL COLLECTORS

Settling Chambers

Particulate matter will fall from suspension in a reasonable time if the particles are larger than about 40 μm. Plenums, dropout boxes, or gravitational settling chambers are thus used for the separation of coarse or abrasive particulate matter from gas streams.

Settling chambers are occasionally used in conjunction with fabric filters or electrostatic precipitators to reduce overall system cost. The settling chamber serves as a precollector to remove coarse particles from the gas stream.

Settling chambers sometimes contain baffles to distribute gas flow and to serve as surfaces for the impingement of coarse particles. Other designs use baffles to change the direction of the gas flow, thereby allowing coarse particles to be thrown from the gas stream by inertial forces.

The fractional efficiency for a settling chamber with uniform gas flow may be estimated by

Table 2 Measures of Performance for Gas-Cleaning Equipment

Type of Particle Collector	Particle Diameter,[a] μm	Max. Loading, g/m³	Collection Efficiency, % by mass	Pressure Loss: Gas, Pa	Pressure Loss: Liquid, kPa	Utilities per m³/s (gas)	Comparative Energy Requirement	Superficial Velocity,[b] m/s	Capacity Limits, m³/s	Space Required (Relative)
Dry inertial collectors										
Settling chamber	>40	>10	50	25 to 125	—	—	1	1.5 to 3.0	None	Large
Baffle chamber	>20	>10	50	125 to 625	—	—	1.5	5.0 to 10	None	Medium
Skimming chamber	>20	>2	70	<250	—	—	3.0	10 to 20	25	Small
Louver	>10	>2	80	75 to 500	—	—	1.5 to 6.0	10 to 20	15	Medium
Cyclone	>15	>2	85	125 to 750	—	—	1.5 to 9.0	10 to 20	25	Medium
Multicyclone	>5	>2	95	500 to 2500	—	—	6.0 to 20	10 to 20	95	Small
Impingement	>10	>2	90	250 to 500	—	—	3.0 to 6.0	10 to 20	None	Small
Dynamic	>10	>2	90	Provides pressure	—	0.75 to 1.5 kW	10 to 20	—	25	—
Electrostatic precipitators										
High-voltage	>0.01	>0.2	99	50 to 250	—	0.1 to 0.6 kW	0.8 to 2.0	0.3 to 2.0	5 to 940	Large
Low-voltage	>0.001	1	90 to 99	50 to 125	—	0.03 to 0.06 kW	0.5 to 1.0	1.0 to 3.5	0.5 to 50	Medium
Fabric filters										
Baghouses	>0.08	.>1	99	500 to 1500	—	—	6.0 to 20	0.005 to 0.10	95	Large
Cartridge filters	>0.05	>0.2	99+	500 to 2000	—			0.0025 to 0.025	20 to 25	Medium
Wet scrubbers										
Gravity spray	>10	>2	70	25 to 250	140 to 690	70 to 270 L/s	5.0	0.5 to 1	50	Medium
Centrifugal	>5	>2	90	500 to 2000	140 to 690	0.14 to 1.4 L/s	12 to 26	10 to 20	50	Medium
Impingement	>5	>2	95	500 to 2000	140 to 690	0.14 to 0.7 L/s	9.0 to 31	15 to 30	50	Medium
Packed bed	>5	>0.2	90	125 to 2500	35 to 210	0.7 to 70 L/s	4.0 to 34	0.5 to 1.5	25	Medium
Dynamic	>2	>2	95	Provides pressure	35 to 210	0.14 to 0.7 L/s, 2.25 to 15 kW	30 to 200	15 to 20	25 25	Small
Submerged orifice	>2	>0.2	90	500 to 1500	None	No pumping	9.0 to 21	15	25	Medium
Jet	>2	>0.2	90	Provides pressure	345 to 610	7 to 14 L/s	15 to 30	10 to 100	50	Small
Venturi	>0.1	>0.2	95 to 99	2500 to 15 000	70 to 210	0.4 to 1.4 L/s	30 to 300	60 to 210	50	Small

Source: IGCI (1964). Information updated by ASHRAE Technical Committee 5.4.
[a]Minimum particle diameter for which the device is effective.
[b]Average speed of gases flowing through the equipment's collection region.

$$\eta = 100 u_t L / HV \quad (4)$$

where

η = efficiency of collector for particles with settling velocity u_t, %
u_t = settling velocity for selected particles, m/s
L = length of chamber, m
H = height of chamber, m
V = superficial velocity of gases through chamber, m/s

The **superficial velocity** of gases through the chamber is determined from measurements of the volumetric flow of gases entering and exiting the chamber and the cross-sectional area of the chamber. This average velocity must be low enough to prevent reentrainment of the deposited dust; a superficial velocity below 0.3 m/s is satisfactory for many materials.

Typical data on settling can be found in Table 4. Because of air inclusions in the particle, the density of a dust particle can be substantially lower than the true density of the material from which it is made.

Inertial Collectors

Louver and Baffle Collectors. Louvers are widely used to control particles larger than about 15 μm in diameter. The louvers cause a sudden change in direction of gas flow. By virtue of their inertia, particles move away from high-velocity gases and are either collected in a hopper or trap or withdrawn in a concentrated sidestream. The sidestream is cleaned using a cyclone or high-efficiency collector, or it is simply discharged to the atmosphere. In general, the pressure drop across inertial collectors with louvers or baffles is greater than that for settling chambers, but this loss is balanced by higher collection efficiency and more compact equipment.

Inertial collectors are occasionally used to control mist. In some applications, the interior of the collector may be irrigated to prevent reentrainment of dry dust and to remove soluble deposits.

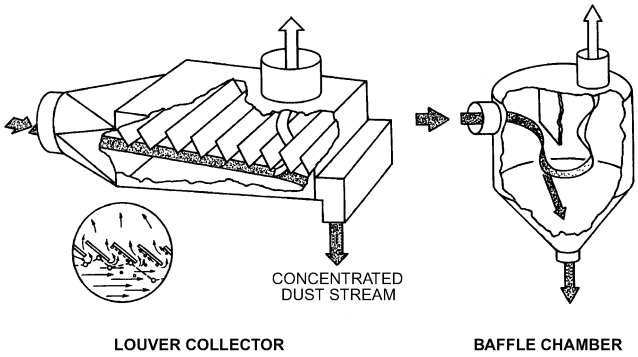


Fig. 1 Typical Louver and Baffle Collectors

Typical louver and baffle collectors are shown in Figure 1.

2.2 CENTRIFUGAL COLLECTORS

Cyclone

Centrifugal collectors are more commonly known as **cyclones** and depend on centrifugal force to move dust particles toward the wall of the collection chamber. Dust-laden air enters the collector tangentially at the top and the flow forms a vortex as it travels down the inside vertical wall or barrel of the cyclone. The tangential forces propel the particles toward the wall. In the whirling airstream, these particles are held against the wall by centrifugal forces, agglomerate, and slide downward toward the cone of the hopper.

The efficiency of a cyclone depends on particle density, shape, and size (aerodynamic size D_p, which is the average of the size

Table 3 Collectors Used in Industry

Operation	Concentration	Particle Size	Cyclone	High-Efficiency Centrifugal	Rotating Centrifugal Mist	Wet Collectors		Self-Cleaning Fabric Filter	Disposable Media Filter	Electrostatic Precipitators		Notes
						Medium-Pressure	High-Energy			High-Voltage	Low-Voltage	
Ceramics												
Raw product handling	Light	Fine	Rare	Seldom	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Frequent	N/A	N/U	N/A	1
Fettling	Light	Fine to medium	Rare	Occasional	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Frequent	N/A	N/U	N/A	2
Refractory sizing	Heavy	Coarse	Seldom	Occasional	N/A	Frequent	Rare	Frequent	N/A	N/U	N/A	3
Glaze and vitreous enamel spray	Moderate	Medium	N/U	N/U	N/A	Usual	N/U	Occasional	N/A	N/A	N/A	—
Glass melting	Light	Fine	N/A	N/A	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Occasional	N/A	Usual	N/A	—
Frit smelting	Light	Fine	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/U	Often	Often	N/A	Often	N/A	—
Fiberglass forming and curing	Light	Fine	N/A	N/A	N/A	Occasional	N/U	N/U	Rare	Usual	N/A	—
Chemicals												
Material handling	Light to moderate	Fine to medium	Occasional	Frequent	N/A	Frequent	Frequent	Frequent	N/A	N/U	N/A	4
Crushing, grinding	Moderate to heavy	Fine to coarse	Often	Frequent	N/A	Frequent	Occasional	Frequent	N/A	N/U	N/A	5
Pneumatic conveying	Very heavy	Fine to coarse	Usual	Occasional	N/A	Rare	Rare	Usual	N/A	N/U	N/A	6
Roasters, kilns, coolers	Heavy	Medium to coarse	Occasional	Usual	N/A	Usual	Frequent	Rare	N/A	Often	N/A	7
Incineration	Light to medium	Fine	N/U	N/U	N/A	N/U	Frequent	Rare	N/A	Frequent	N/A	8
Coal mining and handling												
Material handling	Moderate	Medium	Rare	Occasional	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Usual	N/A	N/A	N/A	9
Bunker ventilation	Moderate	Fine	Occasional	Frequent	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Usual	N/A	N/A	N/A	10
Dedusting, air cleaning	Heavy	Medium to coarse	Occasional	Frequent	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Usual	N/A	N/A	N/A	11
Drying	Moderate	Fine	Rare	Occasional	N/A	Frequent	Occasional	N/U	N/A	N/A	N/A	12
Combustion fly ash												
Coal burning:												
Chain grate	Light	Fine	N/A	Rare	N/A	N/U	N/U	Frequent	N/A	N/U	N/A	13
Spreader stoker	Moderate	Fine to coarse	Rare	Rare	N/A	N/U	N/U	Frequent	N/A	Rare	N/A	14
Pulverized coal	Heavy	Fine	N/A	Frequent	N/A	N/U	N/U	Frequent	N/A	Usual	N/A	14
Fluidized bed	Moderate	Fine	Usual	—	N/A	—	—	Frequent	N/A	Frequent	N/A	—
Coal slurry	Light	—	—	—	N/A	—	—	Often	N/A	Often	N/A	—
Wood waste	Varied	Coarse	Usual	Usual	N/A	N/U	N/U	Occasional	N/A	Often	N/A	15
Municipal refuse	Light	Fine	N/U	N/U	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Usual	N/A	Frequent	N/A	—
Oil	Light	Fine	N/U	N/U	N/A	N/U	N/U	Usual	N/A	Often	N/A	—
Biomass	Moderate	Fine to coarse	N/U	N/U	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Usual	N/A	Frequent	N/A	—
Foundry												
Shakeout	Light to moderate	Fine	Rare	Rare	N/A	Rare	Seldom	Usual	N/A	N/U	N/A	16
Sand handling	Moderate	Fine to medium	Rare	Rare	N/A	Usual	N/U	Rare	N/A	N/U	N/A	17
Tumbling mills	Moderate	Medium to coarse	N/A	N/A	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Usual	N/A	N/U	N/A	18
Abrasive cleaning	Moderate to heavy	Fine to medium	N/A	Occasional	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Usual	N/A	N/U	N/A	19
Grain elevator, flour and feed mills												
Grain handling	Light	Medium	Usual	Occasional	N/A	Rare	N/U	Frequent	N/A	N/A	N/A	20
Grain drying	Light	Coarse	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/U	N/U	See Note 20	N/A	N/A	N/A	21
Flour dust	Moderate	Medium	Rare	Often	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Usual	N/A	N/A	N/A	22
Feed mill	Moderate	Medium	Often	Often	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Frequent	N/A	N/A	N/A	23
Metal melting												
Steel blast furnace	Heavy	Varied	Frequent	Rare	N/A	Frequent	Frequent	N/U	N/A	Frequent	N/A	24
Steel open hearth, basic oxygen furnace	Moderate	Fine to coarse	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	Often	Rare	N/A	Frequent	N/A	25
Steel electric furnace	Light	Fine	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	Occasional	Usual	N/A	Rare	N/A	26
Ferrous cupola	Moderate	Varied	N/A	N/A	N/A	Frequent	Often	Frequent	N/A	Occasional	N/A	27
Nonferrous reverberatory furnace	Varied	Fine	N/A	N/A	N/A	Rare	Occasional	Usual	N/A	N/U	N/A	28
Nonferrous crucible	Light	Fine	N/A	N/A	N/A	Rare	Rare	Occasional	N/A	N/U	N/A	29

Table 3 Collectors Used in Industry (*Continued*)

Operation	Concentration	Particle Size	Cyclone	High-Efficiency Centrifugal	Rotating Centrifugal Mist	Wet Collectors		Self-Cleaning Fabric Filter	Disposable Media Filter	Electrostatic Precipitators		Notes
						Medium-Pressure	High-Energy			High-Voltage	Low-Voltage	
Metal mining and rock products												
Material handling	Moderate	Fine to medium	Rare	Occasional	N/A	Usual	N/U	Considerable	N/A	N/U	N/A	30
Dryers, kilns	Moderate	Medium to coarse	Frequent	Occasional	N/A	Frequent	Occasional	N/U	N/A	Occasional	N/A	31
Cement rock dryer	Moderate	Fine to medium	N/A	Frequent	N/A	Occasional	Rare	N/U	N/A	Occasional	N/A	30
Cement kiln	Heavy	Fine to medium	N/A	Frequent	N/A	Rare	N/U	Usual	N/A	Usual	N/A	32
Cement grinding	Moderate	Fine	N/A	Rare	N/A	N/U	N/U	Usual	N/A	Rare	N/A	33
Cement clinker cooler	Moderate	Coarse	N/A	Occasional	N/A	N/U	N/U	Occasional	N/A	N/U	N/A	34
Metal working												
Production grinding, scratch brushing, abrasive cutoff	Light	Coarse	Occasional	Frequent	N/A	Considerable	N/U	Considerable	N/A	N/U	N/A	35
Portable and swing frame	Light	Medium	Rare	Frequent	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Considerable	N/A	N/U	N/A	—
Buffing	Light	Varied	Frequent	Rare	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Rare	N/A	N/U	N/A	36
Tool room	Light	Fine	Frequent	Frequent	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Frequent	N/A	N/U	N/A	37
Cast-iron machining	Moderate	Varied	Rare	Frequent	N/A	Considerable	N/U	Considerable	N/A	N/U	N/A	38
Steel, brass, aluminum machining	Light to moderate	1 μm smoke, med. mist to solids	N/A	N/A	Frequent	Occasional	N/U	Occasional	Frequent	N/U	Frequent	39
Welding	Light to moderate	1 μm fume to med.	N/A	N/A	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Frequent	Frequent	Rare	Occasional	40
Plasma and laser cutting	Moderate		N/A	N/A	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Frequent	Rare	N/A	N/U	41
Laser welding	Moderate		N/A	N/A	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Frequent	Rare	N/A	N/U	41
Abrasive machining	Moderate to heavy	Fine to 1 μm	N/A	N/U	Occasional	Occasional	N/U	Rare	Frequent	N/A	Rare	39
Milling, turning, cutting tools	Light to moderate	Fine to 1 μm	N/A	N/U	Frequent	Occasional	N/U	N/A	Frequent	N/A	Frequent	—
Annealing, heat treating, induction heating, quenching	Moderate to heavy	1 μm	N/A	N/U	N/A	Rare	Rare	N/A	Rare	N/A	Frequent	—
Pharmaceutical and food products												
Mixers, grinders, weighting, blending, bagging, packaging	Light	Medium	Rare	Frequent	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Frequent	Occasional	N/U	N/U	42
Coating pans	Varied	Fine to medium	Rare	Rare	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Frequent	Rare	N/U	N/U	43
Plastics												
Raw material processing	(See comments under Chemicals)											44
Plastic finishing	Light to moderate	Varied	Frequent	Frequent	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Frequent	Rare	N/U	N/U	45
Molding, extruding, curing	Light to moderate	1 μm smoke	N/A	N/A	N/A	Rare	N/U	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Considerable	46
Pulp and paper												
Recovery boilers:												
Direct contact	Heavy	Medium	N/U	N/U	N/A	N/U	N/U	Occasional	N/A	Usual	N/A	—
Low odor	Heavy	Medium	N/U	N/U	N/A	N/U	N/U	Occasional	N/A	Usual	N/A	—
Lime kilns	Heavy	Coarse	N/U	N/U	N/A	N/U	N/U	Often	N/A	Often	N/A	—
Wood-chip dryers	Varied	Fine to coarse	N/U	N/U	N/A	N/U	N/U	Occasional	N/A	Often	N/A	—
Rubber products												
Mixers	Moderate	Fine	N/A	N/A	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Usual	Rare	N/U	N/U	47
Batch-out rolls	Light	Fine	N/A	N/A	N/A	Usual	N/U	Frequent	N/A	N/U	Rare	48
Talc dusting and dedusting	Moderate	Medium	N/A	N/A	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Usual	Rare	N/U	N/U	49
Grinding	Moderate	Coarse	Often	Often	N/A	Frequent	N/U	Often	Rare	N/U	N/U	50
Molding, extruding, curing	Light to moderate	1 μm smoke	N/A	N/A	N/A	Rare	N/U	N/A	Occasional	N/A	Considerable	46
Wood particle board and hard board												
Particle dryers	Moderate	Fine to coarse	Usual	Occasional	N/A	Frequent	Occasional	Rare	N/A	Occasional	Rare	51
Woodworking												
Woodworking machines	Moderate	Varied	Usual	Occasional	N/A	Rare	N/U	Frequent	N/A	N/U	N/A	52
Sanding	Moderate	Fine	Frequent	Occasional	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Frequent	Rare	N/U	N/A	53
Waste conveying, hogs	Heavy	Varied	Usual	Rare	N/A	Occasional	N/U	Occasional	N/A	N/U	N/A	54

Source: Kane and Alden (1982). Information updated by ASHRAE Technical Committee 5.4.

Notes for Table 3

Definitions
N/A: Not applicable because of inefficiency or process incompatibility.
N/U: Not widely used.
Particle size
Fine: 50% in 0.5 to 7 μm diameter range
Medium: 50% in 7 to 15 μm diameter range
Coarse: 50% over 15 μm diameter range
Concentration of particulate matter entering collector (loading)
Light: <4 g/m^3
Moderate: 4 to 10 g/m^3
Heavy: >10 g/m^3

[1] Dust released from bin filling, conveying, weighing, mixing, pressing, forming. Refractory products, dry pan, and screening operations more severe.
[2] Operations found in vitreous enameling, wall and floor tile, pottery.
[3] Grinding wheel or abrasive cutoff operation. Dust abrasive.
[4] Operations include conveying, elevating, mixing, screening, weighing, packaging. Category covers so many different materials that recommendation will vary widely.
[5] Cyclone and high-efficiency centrifugal collectors often act as primary collectors, followed by fabric filters or wet collectors.
[6] Usual setup uses cyclone as product collector followed by fabric filter for high overall collection efficiency.
[7] Dust concentration determines need for dry centrifugal collector; plant location, product value determine need for final collectors. High temperatures are usual, and corrosive gases not unusual. Liquid smoke emissions may be controlled by condensing precipitator systems using low-voltage, two-stage electrostatic precipitators.
[8] Ionizing wet scrubbers are widely used.
[9] Conveying, screening, crushing, unloading.
[10] Remote from other dust-producing points. Separate collector generally used.
[11] Heavy loading suggests final high-efficiency collector for all except very remote locations.
[12] Loadings and particle sizes vary with different drying methods.
[13] Boiler blowdown discharge is regulated, generally for temperature and, in some places, for pH limits; check local environmental codes on sanitary discharge.
[14] Collection for particulate or sulfur control usually requires a scrubber (dry or wet) and a fabric filter or electrostatic precipitator.
[15] Public nuisance from settled wood char indicates collectors are needed.
[16] Hot gases and steam usually involved.
[17] Steam from hot sand, adhesive clay bond involved.
[18] Concentration very heavy at start of cycle.
[19] Heaviest load from airless blasting because of high cleaning speed. Abrasive shattering greater with sand than with grit or shot. Amounts removed greater with sand castings, less with forging scale removal, least when welding scale is removed.
[20] Operations such as car unloading, conveying, weighing, storing.
[21] Special filters are successful.
[22] In addition to grain handling, cleaning rolls, sifters, purifiers, conveyors, as well as storing, packaging operations are involved.
[23] In addition to grain handling, bins, hammer mills, mixers, feeders, conveyors, bagging operations need control.
[24] Primary dry trap and wet scrubbing usual. Electrostatic precipitators are added where maximum cleaning is required.
[25] Air pollution control is expensive for open hearth, accelerating the use of substitute melting equipment, such as basic oxygen process and electric-arc furnace.
[26] Fabric filters have found extensive application for this air pollution control problem.
[27] Cupola control varies with plant size, location, melt rate, and air pollution emission regulations.
[28] Corrosive gases can be a problem, especially in secondary aluminum.
[29] Zinc oxide plume can be troublesome in certain plant locations.
[30] Crushing screening, conveying, storing involved. Wet ores often introduce water vapor in exhaust airstream.
[31] Dry centrifugal collectors are used as primary collectors, followed by a final cleaner.
[32] Collectors usually allow salvage of material and also reduce nuisance from settled dust in plant area.
[33] Salvage value of collected material is high. Same equipment used on raw grinding before calcining.
[34] Coarse abrasive particles readily removed in primary collector types.
[35] Roof discoloration, deposition on autos can occur with cyclones and, less frequently, with dry centrifugal. Heavy-duty air filter sometimes used as final cleaner.
[36] Linty particles and sticky buffing compounds can cause trouble in high-efficiency centrifugals and fabric filters. Fire hazard is also often present.
[37] Unit collectors extensively used, especially for isolated machine tools.
[38] Dust ranges from chips to fine floats, including graphitic carbon.
[39] Coolant mist and thermal smoke, often with solid swarf particulate entrained.
[40] Submicrometre smoke. Arc welding creates mostly dry metal oxide particulate, sometimes with liquid oil smoke. Resistance welding usually creates only liquid oil smoke, unless done at extremely high currents that vaporize some of the metal being welded.
[41] Plasma and laser cutting and welding of clean metals usually creates dry submicrometre smoke, but oily work pieces frequently generate a sticky mix of liquid and solid submicrometre smoke or fume.
[42] Materials involved vary widely. Collector selection may depend on salvage value, toxicity, sanitation yardsticks.
[43] Controlled temperature and humidity of supply air to coating pans makes recirculation from coating pans desirable.
[44] Manufacture of plastic compounds involves operations allied to many in chemical field and vanes with the basic process used.
[45] Operations are similar to woodworking, and collector selection involves similar considerations.
[46] Submicrometre liquid smoke is frequently emitted when plastic and rubber products are heated.
[47] Concentration is heavy during feed operation. Carbon black and other fine additions make collection and dust-free disposal difficult.
[48] Often, no collection equipment is used where dispersion from exhaust stack is good and stack location is favorable.
[49] Salvage of collected material often dictates type of high-efficiency collector.
[50] Fire hazard from some operations must be considered.
[51] Granular-bed filters, at times electrostatically augmented, have occasionally been used in this application.
[52] Bulky material. Storage for collected material is considerable; bridging from splinters and chips can be a problem.
[53] Production sanding produces heavy concentrations of particles too fine to be effectively captured by cyclones or dry centrifugal collectors.
[54] Primary collector invariably indicated with concentration and partial size range involved; when used, wet or fabric collectors are used as final collectors.

Table 4 Terminal Settling Velocities of Particles, m/s

Particle Density, kg/m^3	1	2	5	10	20	50	100	200	500	1000
50	1.8 E–6	7.0 E–6	4.0 E–5	1.6 E–4	7.0 E–4	4.0 E–3	1.6 E–2	0.055	0.23	0.51
100	3.7 E–6	1.4 E–5	8.0 E–5	3.2 E–4	1.4 E–3	8.0 E–3	3.0 E–2	0.11	0.39	0.83
200	7.4 E–6	2.8 E–5	1.6 E–4	6.4 E–4	2.8 E–3	1.6 E–2	5.9 E–2	0.19	0.65	1.30
500	1.8 E–5	7.0 E–5	4.0 E–4	1.6 E–3	7.0 E–3	3.9 E–2	0.14	0.42	1.21	2.50
1000	3.7 E–5	1.4 E–4	8.0 E–4	3.2 E–3	1.2 E–2	7.6 E–2	0.25	0.70	1.95	3.90
2000	7.4 E–5	2.8 E–4	1.6 E–3	6.4 E–3	2.5 E–2	0.14	0.45	1.14	3.10	6.25
5000	1.8 E–4	7.0 E–4	4.0 E–3	1.5 E–2	6.4 E–2	0.35	0.97	2.23	5.75	11.0
10 000	3.7 E–4	1.4 E–3	8.0 E–3	3.1 E–2	0.12	0.60	1.66	3.52	8.90	17.3

Note: E–6 = ×10^{-6}, etc. *Source*: Billings and Wilder (1970).

range), the exerted force, and the time that the force is exerted on the dust particles. Cyclone efficiency may be estimated from Figure 2.

The parameter D_{pc}, known as the **cut size**, is defined as the diameter of particles collected with 50% efficiency. The cut size may be estimated using the following equation:

$$D_{pc} = \sqrt{\frac{1.4\mu b}{N_e V_i (\rho_p - \rho_g)\pi}} \quad (5)$$

where

D_{pc} = cut size, m
μ = absolute gas viscosity, Pa·s
b = cyclone inlet width, m
N_e = effective number of turns in cyclone; approximately 5 for a high-efficiency cyclone and may be from 0.5 to 10 for other cyclones
V_i = inlet gas velocity, m/s
ρ_p = density of particle material, kg/m^3
ρ_g = density of gas, kg/m^3

Early designers of cyclones realized the correlation between higher efficiencies and greater pressure drops, and made cyclones smaller. To improve cyclonic efficiencies and lower pressure drop, multiple cyclone collectors with vane spinners were developed (Figure 3). Dirty air enters the inlet plenum and is diverted into

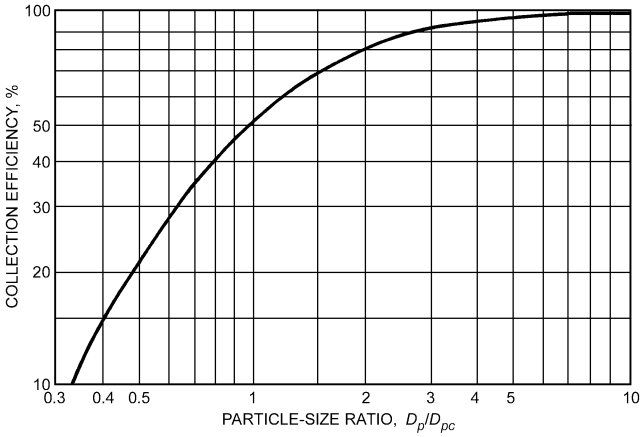


Fig. 2 Cyclone Efficiency

(Lapple 1951)

multiple tubes with turning vanes. These vanes create a centrifugal spin that separates dust from the airstream. The dust slides down the tube into the discharge hopper, while the clean gas rises through the center of the tube and is exhausted from the outlet. These multiple cyclones were often applied in boilers and other high-temperature applications as the only acceptable dust collectors.

Dust-carrying capacities of cyclones have two opposite characteristics. In general, small-diameter cyclones collect dust efficiently even at relatively low loads (0.0002 to 0.014 g/L), but the pressure drop will range from 1.5 to 2.5 kPa. However, at high dust loads, some of the dust outlets may tend to plug. Large-diameter cyclones can handle dust loads in the 0.11 to 0.23 g/L range with low pressure drops (0.37 to 0.75 kPa), but the collector efficiency will be lower at low dust loads because the dust particles may be swept from the walls of the collector before the dust particles can agglomerate. Currently, cyclones are broken down into grades as shown in Table 2.

The progression from low to high efficiency is achieved by reducing the diameter of the cyclone and altering the geometry to meet the airflow, pressure drop, and efficiency of the required application. The progression to ultrahigh efficiency (UHE) is a large leap. A tradeoff exists between separation efficiency and energy consumption. More energy is required in the form of static pressure to overcome the additional resistance of a smaller-diameter and longer-bodied cyclone. Although UHE cyclones can achieve the same level of emissions as filter media dust collectors; the UHE cyclone will cost more upfront; however, with no moving parts, the ease of operation can pay for itself. Like all cyclones, UHE cyclones are not appropriate for all applications and will depend on the dust collected. In additional to dust particle size and density, the particle aerodynamics must be considered (e.g., wood chips will act must differently than lead fines).

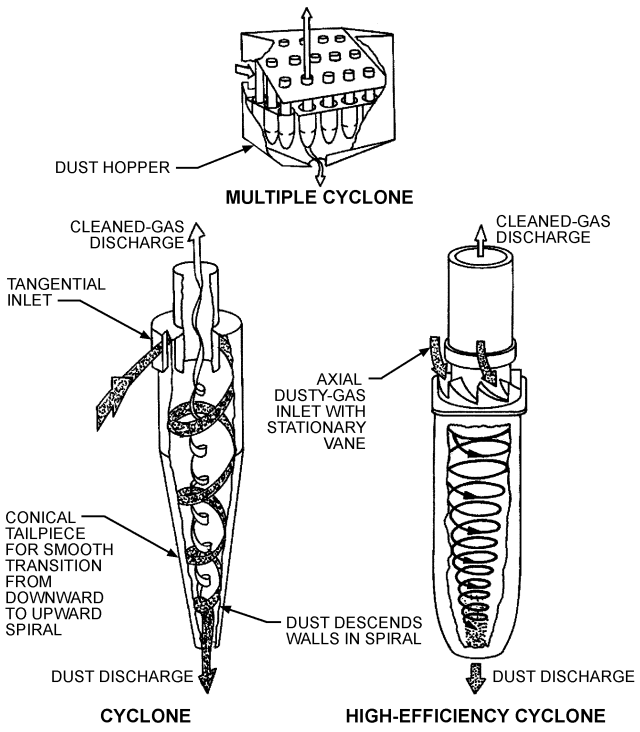


Fig. 3 Typical Cyclone Collectors

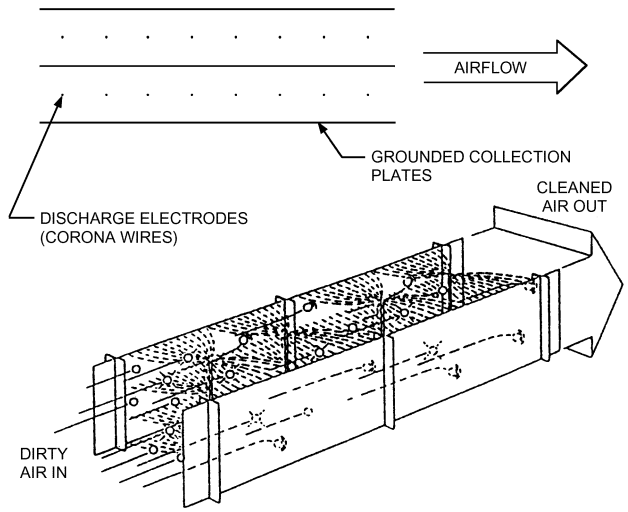


Fig. 4 Typical Single-Stage Electrostatic Precipitator

2.3 ELECTROSTATIC PRECIPITATORS

Electrostatic precipitators use the forces acting on charged particles passing through an electric field to separate those particles from the airstream in which they were suspended. In every precipitator, three distinct functions must be accomplished:

- **Ionization:** charging contaminant particles
- **Collection:** subjecting particles to a precipitating force that moves them toward collecting electrodes
- **Collector cleaning:** removing collected contaminant from precipitator

Units in which ionization and collection are accomplished simultaneously in a single structure are called **single-stage precipitators** (Figure 4). They have widely spaced electrodes (80 to 150 mm) and typically operate with high voltages (20 to 60 kV) but relatively low (rarely as high as 0.43 kV/mm) field gradients.In **two-stage precipitators**, ionization and collection are performed independently in discrete charging and precipitating structures (Figure 5). Because their ionizing and collecting electrodes are closely spaced (18 to 38 mm), two-stage precipitators normally operate with high field gradients (usually more than 0.39 kV/mm) but low voltages (usually 10 kV or less, and never more than 14 kV) (White 1963).

Because of fundamental differences in their ionization processes and practical differences in the way they are usually constructed, high-voltage (single-stage) and low-voltage (two-stage) precipitators are suited for entirely different air-cleaning requirements.

Single-Stage Designs

Figure 6 shows several types of single-stage precipitators. The charging electrodes are located between parallel collecting plates. The gas flows horizontally through the precipitators. High-voltage precipitators collect larger particles better than small particles (they are less efficient at collecting contaminants smaller than 1 to 2 μm). Their precipitation efficiency depends in part on the relative electrical resistivity of the pollutant being collected; most are less efficient when collecting either conductive or highly dielectric contaminants.

Single-stage high-voltage precipitators can easily handle heavy loadings of dry dust. Most are configured to operate continuously (using online vibratory or shaker cleaning). They can continuously collect large quantities (hundreds of kilograms per hour) of airborne materials such as foundry shakeout, cement, ceramics, chemical dusts, fly ash, blast furnace dust and fumes, and paper mill recovery boiler emissions.

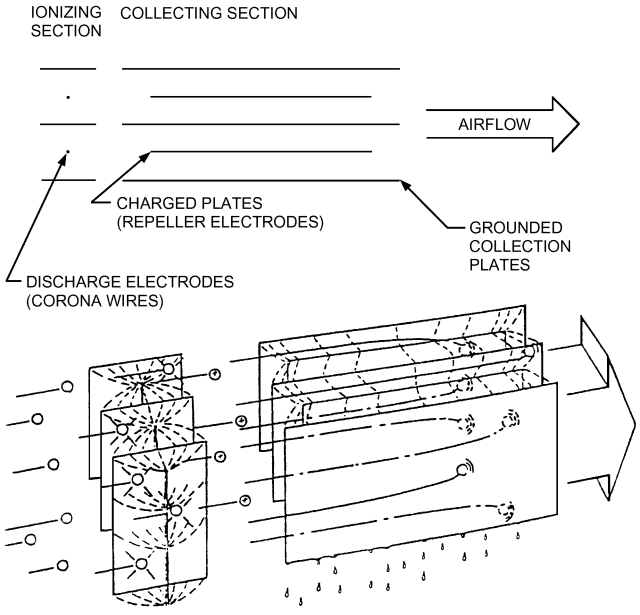


Fig. 5 Typical Two-Stage Electrostatic Precipitators

Although they are rarely used to clean exhaust airflows much smaller than 25 m^3/s, single-stage precipitators can be constructed to handle airflows as large as 1000 m^3/s. Gas velocity through the electrostatic field is ordinarily 0.3 to 2 m/s, with treatment time in the range of 2 to 10 s. Only special-purpose single-stage "wet" precipitators are configured for collection of liquid contaminants.

Single-stage industrial electrostatic precipitators are distinguished from low-voltage two-stage precipitator designs by several attributes:

- Separation between the electrodes is larger to secure acceptable collection and electrode cleaning under the high dust loading and hostile conditions of industrial gas streams.
- Construction is heavy-duty for operation to 450°C and +7.5 kPa.
- They are generally used for exhaust applications where ozone generation is not of concern. Consequently, they may operate with negative ionization, the polarity that gives the maximum electric field strength between the electrodes.
- They are normally custom-engineered and assembled on location for a particular application.

Single-stage precipitators can be designed to operate at collection efficiencies above 99.9% for closely specified conditions. Properties of the dust, such as particle size distribution and a deposit's electrical resistivity, can affect performance significantly, as can variations in gas composition and flow rate.

Two-Stage Designs

Two-stage precipitators are manufactured in two general forms: (1) electronic air cleaners, which are commonly used for light dust loadings in commercial/residential ventilation and air-conditioning service (see Chapter 29); and (2) heavy-duty industrial electrostatic precipitators designed primarily to handle the heavy loadings of submicrometre liquid particulates that are emitted from hot industrial processes and machining operations. Two-stage industrial precipitators often include sumps and drainage provisions that encourage continuous gravity runoff of collected liquids (Beck 1975; Shabsin 1985).

Two-stage precipitators are frequently used in industry to collect submicrometre pollutants that would be difficult (or impossible) to collect in other types of equipment. Two-stage precipitators are frequently sized to handle less than 0.5 m^3/s of air and rarely built to handle more than 25 to 35 m^3/s of contaminated air in one unit. Gas velocity through the collecting fields usually ranges from 1 to 3.5 m/

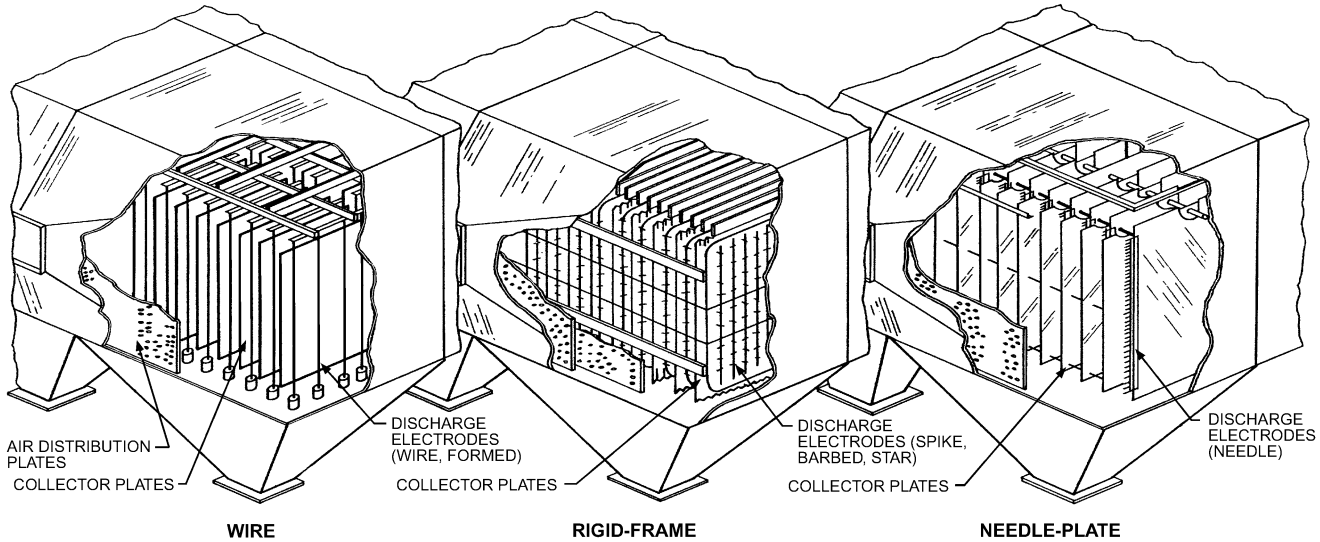


Fig. 6 Typical Single-Stage Precipitators

s, with treatment times per pass of 0.015 to 0.05 s in the ionizing fields and 0.06 to 0.25 s in the collecting fields.

Because gravity drainage of precipitated liquid smoke or fog is a dependable collector-cleaning mechanism, low-voltage two-stage precipitators are most often recommended to collect liquefiable pollutants in which few (or no) solids are entrained.

Since the early 1970s, an important application for low-voltage two-stage electrostatic precipitators has been as the gas-cleaning component of **condensing precipitator systems**. Design of these air pollution control systems (and of similar **condensing filtration systems**) is based on the following principle: although the hot gases or fumes emitted by many processes are not easily filtered or precipitated (because they are in the vapor phase), the condensation aerosol fogs or smokes that form as those vaporized pollutants cool can be efficiently collected by filtration or precipitation (Figure 7). Many condensation aerosol smokes consist of submicrometre liquid droplets, making them a good match for the collecting capability of low-voltage two-stage precipitators (Rossnagel 1973; Sauerland 1976; Thiel 1977).

Low-voltage precipitators can be very effective at collecting the aerosol particles smaller than 1 μm (down to 0.001 to 0.01 μm) that are responsible for most plume opacity and for virtually all blue smoke (blue-tinted) emissions. Condensing precipitator systems may therefore be a good choice for eliminating the residual opacity of blue smoke formed by condensation aerosol plumes from hot processes, dryers, ovens, furnaces, or other exhaust air cleaning devices (Beltran 1972; Beltran and Surati 1976; Thiel 1977).

When condensation aerosol pollutants are odorous in character, precipitation of the submicrometre droplets of odorant can prevent the long-distance drift of odorous materials, possibly eliminating neighborhood complaints that are associated with submicrometre particulate smokes. Odors that have been successfully controlled by precipitation include asphalt fumes, food frying smokes, meat smokehouse smoke, plasticizer smokes, rubber curing smoke, tar, and textile smokes (Chopyk and Larkin 1982; Thiel 1983).

2.4 FABRIC FILTERS

Fabric filters are dry dust collectors that use a stationary medium to capture the suspended dust and remove it from the gas stream. This medium, called fabric, can be composed of a wide variety of materials, including natural and synthetic cloth, glass fibers, and even paper.

Principle of Operation

When contaminated gases pass through a fabric, particles may attach to the fibers and/or other particles and separate from the gas stream. The particles are normally captured near the inlet side of a fabric to form a deposit known as a **dust cake**. In self-cleaning designs, the dust cake is periodically removed from the fabric to prevent excessive resistance to the gas flow. Finer particles may penetrate more deeply into a fabric and, if not removed during cleaning, may blind it.

Surface-loading-type fabrics can help mitigate this effect by not allowing particles to penetrate as deeply into the fabric. Because particles remain on the surface, instead of being embedded into the fabric, the dust cake releases from the fabric more easily during cleaning. Some examples of surface-loading fabrics are polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE) membrane and nanofiber-coated fabrics.

Self-cleaning fabric filters have several **advantages** over other high-efficiency dust collectors such as electrostatic precipitators and wet scrubbers:

- They provide high efficiency with lower installed cost.
- Particulate matter is collected in the same state in which it was suspended in the gas stream (a significant factor if product recovery is desired).
- Process upsets seldom result in the violation of emission standards. The mass rate of particulate matter escaping collection remains low over the life of the filter media and is insensitive to large changes in the mass-loading of dust entering the collector.

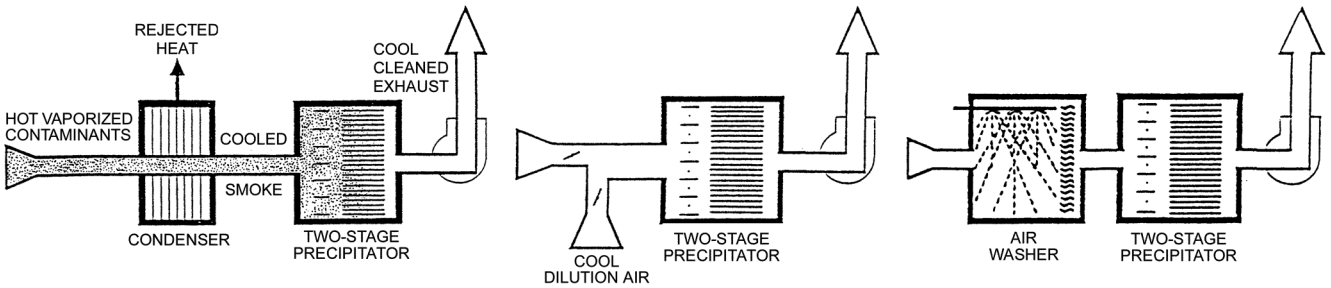
Self-cleaning fabric filter dust collectors also have some **limitations**:

- Liquid aerosols, moist and sticky materials, and condensation blind fabrics and reduce or prevent gas flow. These actions can curtail plant operation.
- Fabric life may be shortened in the presence of acidic or alkaline components in the gas stream.
- Use of fabric filters is generally limited to temperatures below 260°C.
- Should a spark or flame accidently reach the collector, fabrics can contribute to the fire/explosion hazard.
- When a large volume of gas is to be cleaned, the large number of fabric elements (bags, cartridges, or envelopes) required and the maintenance problem of detecting, locating, and replacing a damaged element should be considered. Monitoring equipment can detect leakage in an individual row of filters or an individual bag.

Pressure-Volume Relationships

The size of a fabric filter is based on empirical data on the amount of fabric media required to clean the desired volumetric flow of gas with an acceptable static pressure drop across the media. The appropriate media and conditions for its use are selected by pilot test or from experience with media in similar full-scale installations. These tests provide a recommended range of approach velocities for a specific application.

The **approach velocity** is stated in practical applications as a gas-to-media ratio or filtration velocity (i.e., the velocity at which gas flows through the filter media). The **gas-to-media ratio** is the ratio of the volumetric flow of gases through the fabric filter to the



A. PRINCIPLE OF THE CONDENSING PRECIPITATOR SYSTEM

B. DILUTION-COOLED CONDENSING PRECIPITATOR SYSTEM

C. EVAPORATIVELY COOLED CONDENSING PRECIPITATOR SYSTEM

Fig. 7 Condensing Precipitator Systems for Control of Hot Organic Smokes

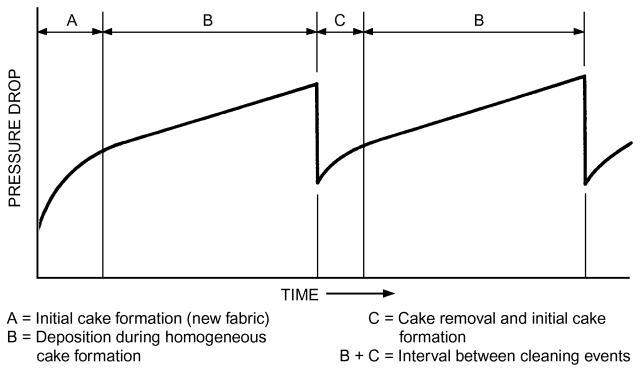


Fig. 8 Time Dependence of Pressure Drop Across Fabric Filter

area of fabric that participates in the filtration. It is the average approach velocity of the gas to the surface of the filter media.

It is difficult to estimate the correlation between pressure drop and gas-to-media ratio for a new installation. However, when flow entering a filter with a dust cake is laminar and uniform, the pressure drop is proportional to the approach velocity:

$$\Delta p = KV_i W = KQW/A \quad (6)$$

where

Δp = pressure drop, Pa
K = specific resistance coefficient, pressure drop per unit air velocity and mass of dust per unit area
V_i = approach velocity or gas-to-media ratio, m/s
W = area density of dust cake, g/m^2
Q = volumetric flow of gases, m^3/s
A = area of cloth that intercepts gases, m^2

Equation (6) suggests that increasing the area of the fabric during initial installation has some advantage. A larger fabric area reduces both the gas-to-media ratio and the thickness of the dust cake, resulting in a decreased pressure drop across the collector and reduced cleaning requirements. A lower gas-to-media ratio generally lowers operational cost for the fabric filter system, extends the useful life of the filter elements, and reduces maintenance frequency and expense. In addition, the lower gas-to-media ratio allows for some expansion of the system and, more importantly, additional surge capacity when upset conditions such as unusually high moisture content occur.

The specific resistance coefficient K is usually higher for fine dusts. The use of a primary collector to remove the coarse fraction seldom causes a significant change in the pressure drop across the collector. In fact, the coarse dust fraction helps reduce operating pressure because it results in a more porous dust cake, which provides better dust cake release.

Figure 8 illustrates the dependence of the pressure drop on time for a single-compartment fabric filter, operating through its cleaning cycle. The volumetric flow, particulate concentration, and distribution of particle sizes are assumed to remain constant. In practice, these assumptions are not usually valid. However, the interval between cleaning events is usually long enough that these variations are insignificant for most systems; between cleaning events, the dependence of pressure drop on time is approximately linear.

The volumetric flow of gases from a process often varies in response to changes in pressure drop across the fabric filter. The degree to which this variation is significant depends on the operating point for the fan and the process requirements.

Fabric Filter Media

Commercially available fabrics, when applied appropriately, will separate 1 μm or larger particles from a gas with an efficiency of 99.9% or better. Particle size is not the major factor influencing efficiency attained from an industrial fabric filter. Most manufacturers of fabric filters will guarantee such efficiencies on applications in which they have prior experience. Lower efficiencies are generally attributed to poor maintenance (torn fabric seams, loose connections, etc.) or the inappropriate selection of lighter/higher-permeability fabrics in an effort to reduce the cost of the collector.

Table 5 Temperature Limits and Characteristics of Fabric Filter Media

	Maximum Continuous Operating Temp., °C	Acid Resistance	Alkali Resistance	Flex Abrasion	Cost Relative to Cotton
Cotton	82	Poor	Very good	Very good	1.00
Wool	93	Good	Poor	Fair to good	2.75
Nylon[a,b]	93	Poor	Excellent	Excellent	2.50
Nomex[a,b]	200	Fair	Very good	Very good	8.00
Acrylic	127	Good	Fair	Good	3.00
Polypropylene	82	Excellent	Excellent	Very good	1.75
Polyethylene	62	Excellent	Excellent	Very good	2.00
Teflon[b]	218	Excellent	Excellent	Good	30.00
Glass fiber	260	Fair to good	Fair to good	Poor	5.00
Polyester[a]	135	Good	Good	Very good	2.50
Cellulose	82	Poor	Good	Good	—

[a]These fibers are subject to hydrolysis when they are exposed to hot, wet atmospheres.
[b]DuPont trademark.

Fabric specifications summarize information on such factors as cost, fiber diameter, type of weave, fabric density, tensile strength, dimensional stability, chemical resistance, finish, permeability, and abrasion resistance. Usually, comparisons are difficult, and the supplier must be relied on to select the appropriate material for the service conditions.

Table 5 summarizes experience with the exposure of fabrics to industrial atmospheres. Although higher temperatures are acceptable for short periods, reduced fabric life can be expected with continued use above the maximum temperature. The filter is often protected from high temperatures by thermostatically controlled air bleed-in or collector bypass dampers.

When the gases are moist or the fabric must collect hygroscopic or sticky materials, **synthetic media** are recommended. They are also recommended for high-temperature gases. Polypropylene is a frequent selection. One limitation of synthetic media is greater penetration of the media during the cleaning cycle.

Woven fabrics are generally porous, and effective filtration depends on prior formation of a dust cake. New cloth collects poorly until particles bridge the openings in the cloth. Once the cake is formed, the initial layers become part of the fabric; they are not destroyed when the bulk of the collected material is dislodged during the cleaning cycle.

Cotton and wool fibers in woven media as well as most felted fabrics accumulate an initial dust cake in a few minutes. Synthetic woven fabrics may require a few hours in the same application because of the smoothness of the monofilament threads. Spun threads in the fill direction, when used, reduce the time required to build up the initial dust cake. Felted fabrics contain no straight-through openings and have a reasonably good efficiency for most particulates, even when clean. After the dust cake builds internally, as well as on the fabric's surface, shaking does not make it porous.

Cartridges manufactured from **pleated paper** and various **synthetic microfibers** (usually spun-bonded, not resin-glued, to form a stiff, nonwoven, microporous media) are also fabric filters because they operate in the same general manner as high-efficiency fabrics.

As with cloth filters, the efficiency of the filter is increased by the formation of a dust cake on the medium.

Media used in cartridge type filters is usually manufactured to have many more pores (through which gas flows while being filtered) than do any of the common baghouse fabrics. Initial filtration efficiency of clean new cartridge filters is usually much greater, particularly for submicrometre-sized dust particles, than that of bare baghouse media (before a significant cake of filtered dust forms) because the pores in cartridge media are much smaller than those in baghouse fabrics. Despite having pores approximately one-tenth the diameter of those in the best baghouse felts, both cellulose (paper) and synthetic (most often polyester) cartridge media have so many pores that their permeability to gas flow is considerably greater than that of commonly used polyester felt baghouse media.

Fabric Filter Media Dust Collector Types

Three types of industrial filter media dust collectors are in common use: disposable-media filters, mechanically cleaned dust collectors, and pulse-cleaned dust collectors. Although most commercially available fabric filter systems are currently one of these three types, design variations among competing products can greatly influence the suitability of a particular collector for a specific air-cleaning application.

Disposable Filter Media Dust Collectors. Disposable-fabric (or disposable-media) filter collectors are usually simple, economical units that hold enough fabric or similar media to collect modest quantities of almost any particulate pollutant, including liquids, solids, and sticky or waxy materials, regardless of particle size (at least for particles large than 0.5 to 1 μm). When each filter has accumulated as much material as it can practically hold, it is discarded and replaced with a new element. Both envelope bag arrays and pleated rectangular cartridge elements are popular media forms for use in disposable filter collectors.

When considering using disposable-media filter collectors, serious attention must be given to safe, legal, and ethical disposal of spent and/or contaminated filter elements.

Mechanically Cleaned Dust Collectors. The most common filter cleaning methods for mechanically cleaned dust collectors are shaking the bags and reversing the flow of gas through the bags. Mechanical cleaning of filter media can only occur when the flow of filtering air through the filter is stopped. Typically, the fan flow is stopped momentarily by a damper in one compartment (or the main fan is turned off), making the filter compartment effectively off-line. Then, the cleaning action occurs with no fan flow moving through the compartment. Generally, large installations are compartmented and use off-line cleaning. Other cleaning methods include shake-deflate, a combination of shaker and reverse air cleaning, and acoustically augmented cleaning.

Shaker Collectors. When a single compartment is needed that can be cleaned off-line during shift change or breaks, shaker-type fabric filters are usually the least expensive choice. The fabric medium in a shaker-type fabric filter, whether formed into cylindrical tubes or rectangular envelopes, is mechanically agitated to remove the dust cake. Figures 9 and 10 show typical shaker-type fabric filters using bag and envelope media, respectively.

When the fabric filter cannot be stopped for cleaning, the collector is divided into a number of independent sections that are sequentially taken off-line for cleaning. Because it is usually difficult to maintain a good seal with dampers, relief dampers are often included. The relief dampers introduce a small volume of reverse gas to keep gas flow at the fabric suitable for cake removal. Use of compartments, with their frequent cleaning cycles, does not allow a substantial increase in flow rates over those of a single-compartment unit cleaned periodically. The best situation for fabric reconditioning is when the system is stopped, because even small particles will then fall into the hopper.

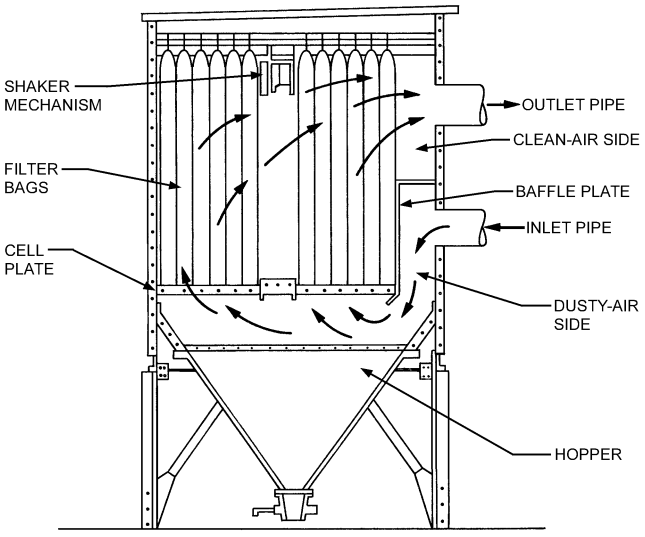


Fig. 9 Bag-Type Shaker Collector

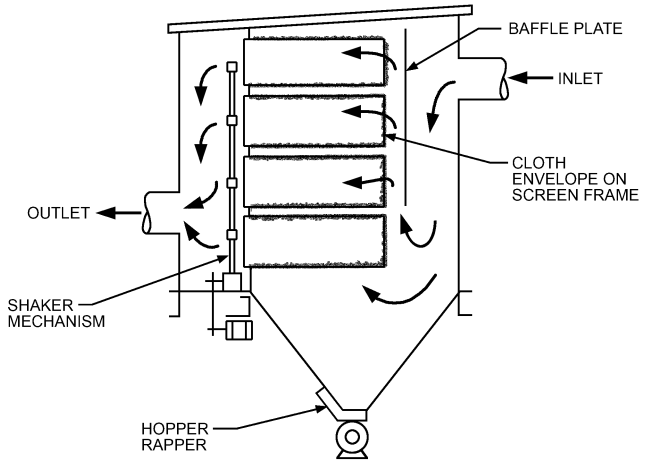


Fig. 10 Envelope-Type Shaker Collector

Figure 11 shows typical pressure diagrams for four- and six-compartment fabric filters that are continuously cleaned with mechanical shakers. Continuously cleaned units have compartment valves that close for the shaking cycle. This diagram is typical for a multiple-compartment fabric filter where individual compartments are cleaned off-line.

The gas-to-media ratio for a shaker-type dust collector is usually in the range of 0.01 to 0.02 m/s; it might be lower where the collector filters particles that are predominantly smaller than 2 μm. The abatement of metallurgical fumes is one example where a shaker collector is used to control particles that are less than 1 μm in size.

The bags are usually 100 to 200 mm in diameter and 3 to 6 m in length, whereas envelope assemblies may be almost any size or shape. For ambient air applications, a woven cotton or polypropylene fabric is usually selected for shaker-type fabric filters. Synthetics are chosen for their resistance to elevated temperature and to chemicals.

Reverse-Flow Collectors. Reverse-flow cleaning is generally chosen when the volumetric flow of gases is very large. This method of cleaning inherently requires a compartmented design because the reverse flow needed to collapse the bags entrains dust

that must be returned to on-line compartments of the fabric filter. Each compartment is equipped with one main shutoff valve and one reverse gas valve (whether the system is blown through or drawn through). A secondary blower and duct system is required to reverse the gas flow in the compartment to be cleaned. When a compartment is isolated for cleaning, the reverse gas circuit increases the volumetric flow and dust loading through the collector's active compartments.

The fabric medium is reconditioned by reversing the direction of flow through the bags, which partially collapse. The cleaning action is illustrated in Figure 12. After cleaning, reintroduction of gas is delayed to allow dislodged dust to fall into the hopper.

Reverse-flow cleaning reduces the number of moving parts in the fabric filter system—a maintenance advantage, especially when large volumetric flows are cleaned. However, the cleaning or reconditioning is less vigorous than other methods, and the residual drag of the reconditioned fabric is higher. Reverse-flow cleaning is particularly suited for fabrics, like glass cloth, that require gentle cleaning.

Reverse-flow bags are usually 200 to 300 mm in diameter and 6 to 10 m long and generally operate at flow velocities in the 0.01 to 0.02 m/s range. As a consequence, reverse-air dust collectors tend to be substantially larger than pulse-jet-cleaned designs of similar capacity.

For ambient air applications, a woven cotton or polypropylene fabric is the usual selection for reverse-flow cleaning. For higher temperatures, woven polyester, glass fiber, or trademarked fabrics are often selected.

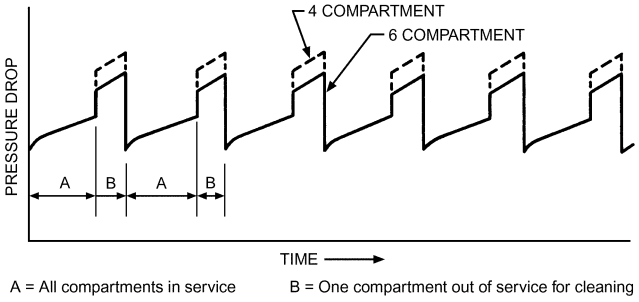


Fig. 11 Pressure Drop Across Shaker Collector Versus Time

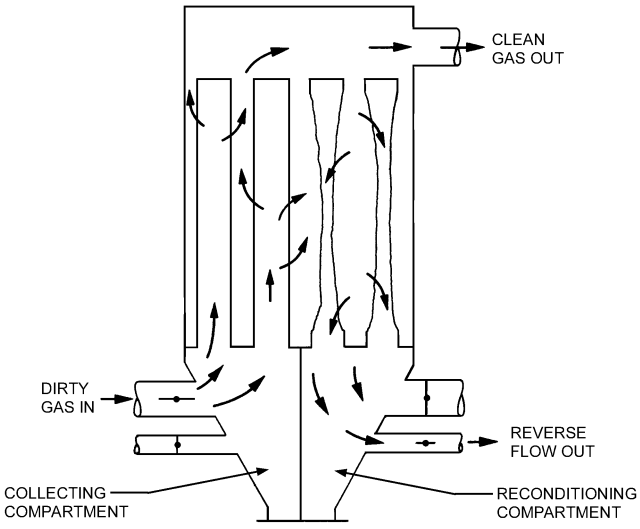


Fig. 12 Draw-Through Reverse-Flow Cleaning of Fabric

Reverse-Air Collectors. These collectors can continuously clean during ongoing industrial processes and without any special compartments. This type of collector became known as an **online cleaning collector**, because it could clean during the industrial process. Filters are cleaned using either a pan, pressure blower, or air pump to blow clean air through a rotating arm exhaust manifold directly above the filter bags. As the clean air manifold rotates, it seals off the filter bags from filtering and back-flushes the filters, with clean air knocking off the accumulated dust. These types of collectors can operate at much higher air-to-cloth ratios than shaker or reverse-flow collectors, and are very effective on a wide range of applications. The disadvantage of this collector type, however, is the multiple drives required to maintain and operate the main exhaust fan, cleaning fan/pump, and rotating arm drive.

Pulse-Cleaned Dust Collectors. These collectors use a common industrial-process resource to clean filters: compressed air. Pulse-cleaned dust collectors (or **pulse-jet**) use a compressed air jet operating for a fraction of a second causes a rapid vibration or ripple in the fabric, which dislodges the accumulated dust cake (Figures 13 and 14). Simultaneously, outflow of both compressed cleaning air and entrained air from the top clean air plenum helps to sweep pulsed-off dust away from the filter surface. The pulse jet design is predominantly used because (1) it is easier to maintain than the reverse-flow mechanism and (2) collectors can be smaller and less costly because the greater useful cleaning energy makes operation with higher filtration velocities practical.

Most pulse jet designs require high-pressure, dry, compressed (up to 700 kPa) air, the cost of which should be considered when air-cleaning systems are designed.

When collecting light or fluffy dust of low bulk density (e.g., arc welding fumes, plasma or laser cutting fumes, finish sanding of wood, fine plastic dusts), serious attention must be given to the direction and velocity at which dust-laden air travels as it moves from the collector inlet to approach the filter media surface. Dusty-air velocity is called **can velocity** and is defined as the actual velocity of airflow approaching the filter surfaces. Can velocity is computed by subtracting the total area occupied by filter elements (bags or cartridges, measured perpendicularly to the direction of gas flow) from

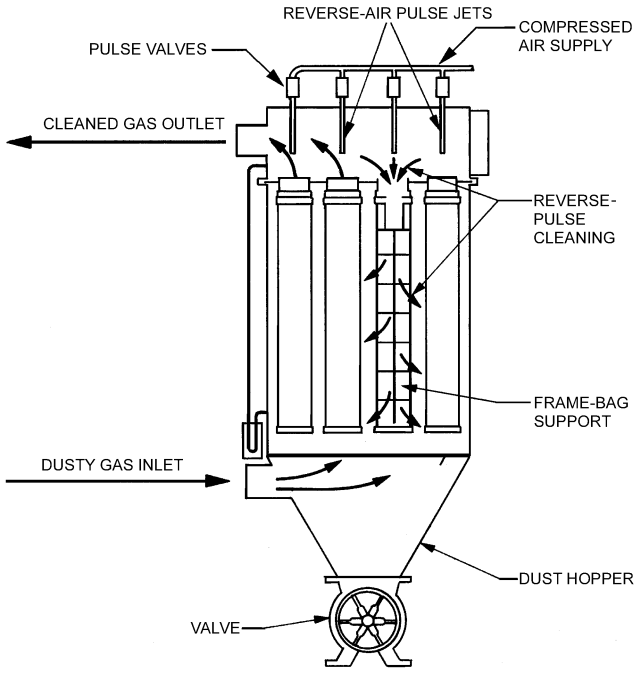


Fig. 13 Typical Pulse-Jet Fabric Filter

the overall cross-sectional area of the collector's dusty-air housing to compute the actual area through which dusty gas flows. The total gas flow being cleaned is then divided by that flow area to yield can velocity:

$$V_c = \frac{Q}{A_h - NA_f} \quad (7)$$

where

V_c = can velocity, m/s
Q = gas flow being cleaned, m^3/s
A_h = cross-sectional area of collector dusty-gas housing, m^2
N = number of filter bags or cartridges in collector
A_f = cross-sectional area, perpendicular to gas flow, of each filter bag or cartridge, m^2

The maximum can velocity in **upflow** collectors (i.e., those in which dusty gas enters through a plenum or hopper beneath the filter elements) is at the bottom end of the filter elements, where the entire gas flow must pass between and around the filters. Unless the maximum can velocity is low enough that pulsed-off dust can fall through the upwardly flowing gas, dust will simply redeposit on filter surfaces. The result is that on-line pulse cleaning cannot function, and the collector must be operated in the downtime pulse mode, with filter cleaning done only when there is no airflow through the collector.

Can velocity is sometimes overlooked when attempting to increase upflow collector capacity with improved fabrics or cartridges. Regardless of the theoretical gas-to-media ratio at which a filter operates, if released dust cannot fall through the rising airflow into the hopper, the collector will not be able to clean itself.

Collector designs in which dusty gas flows **downward** around the filters are much less susceptible to problems caused by high can velocity because the downward gas flow sweeps pulsed-off dust down toward (and into) the bottom dust discharge hopper, from which it can easily be removed.

Types of Pulse Jet Dust Collectors.

- **Baghouses.** Most baghouses (see Figure 13) use flexible cloth or other fabric-like filter media in the shape of long cylindrical bags. The tubular bags are supported by wire cages during normal operation. The reverse-flow pulse breaks up the dust layer on the outside of the bag, and dislodged material eventually falls to a hopper. Filtration velocities for pulse jet designs range from 0.025 to 0.075 m/s for favorable dusts but require greater fabric area for many materials that produce a low-permeability dust cake. Felted fabrics are generally used for these designs because the jet cleaning opens the pores of woven cloth and produces excessive leakage through the filter. Bags in pulse-jet-cleaned systems are rarely more than 160 mm in diameter but can be up to 6 m long. Timed pulses of compressed air flex the bags while blowing collected dust off the media surface. Continuous operation, with no downtime for filter cleaning or dust removal, is common (see Figure 11).
- **Cartridge filters**. These filters (Figure 14) use a nearly identical compressed-air media cleaning system. However, their fabric is relatively rigid material, packaged into pleated cylindrical cartridges. Cartridges are self-supported and much easier to handle and replace than are long tubular baghouse bags. Most cartridges are 325 mm or less in diameter and rarely longer than 760 mm.

  With the pleated media construction, a large filter surface area can be packaged in a relatively small housing to reduce both cost and space required. Most cartridge filter units are not nearly as tall as baghouses having comparable capacity. Pleat depth, spacing, and media material construction are critically important variables that determine the suitability and useful lifetime of particular filter cartridges under the conditions of each specific application.
- **Z-flow pack filters.** These are similar to cartridge filters, but with an even greater density of media. The filter media is corrugated, with alternating ends of the corrugated flutes sealed. Dirty air can enter an open-ended flute that is sealed shut at the other end. The air must pass through the media, and exit via an adjacent flute. The dust contaminant is trapped on the media surface. Z-flow packs use cleaning systems nearly identical to those of cartridge systems.

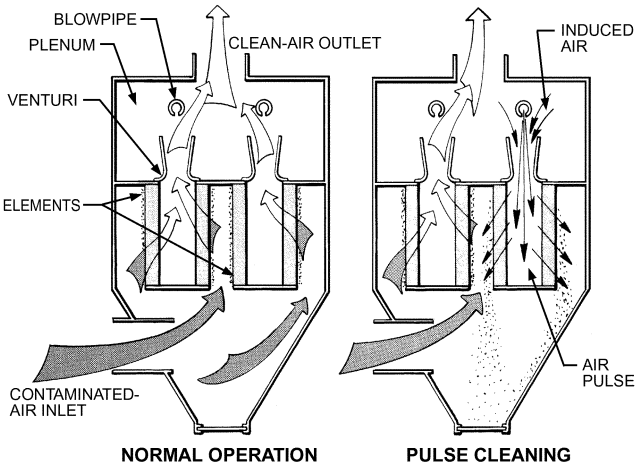


Fig. 14 Pulse Jet Cartridge Filters (Upflow Design with Vertical Filters)

Baghouse, cartridge, and Z-flow pack filter systems are practical only when airborne contaminants consist almost exclusively of dry dust. The presence of any entrained liquid in the airstream usually creates a severe maintenance problem because the filter self-cleaning systems (pulse jet, reverse air, or shaker) become less effective, so the filters become plugged or "blinded" by collected material and fail after only brief operation.

Conservatively selected and carefully applied baghouse, cartridge, and Z-flow filter systems, on the other hand, can easily provide excellent dust collection performance with a filter service life of more than 1 year. They often require very little maintenance, even when handling heavy dust loads in continuous 24 h, 7 day operation.

This chapter cannot adequately cover all the collector design variables and experience-related factors that must be considered when deciding which baghouse or cartridge self-cleaning dust collector design is best suited for each particular application. Engineers making dust collector selections are encouraged to discuss all aspects of each application in detail with all vendors being considered. It is necessary to judge

- The relative expertise of each prospective vendor
- Which dust collector design is most desirable
- How much media surface is needed in each design for each specified gas flow rate
- Which filter media is best suited to the particular application
- In the case of pulse-jet-cleaned cartridge collectors, what pleat spacing and pleat depth will give optimum or acceptable dust cake removal performance under the particular application conditions

2.5 MIST COLLECTORS

Mist collectors are wet filtration systems that separate wet particles out of the airstream and return cleaned air back into the workplace. Various filtration and particle separation technologies exist, including fiber bed filters, panel filters, high loft bag filters, centrifugal filters, and electrostatic precipitators (ESP). Each technology has its advantages and disadvantages depending on what its collecting and filtering out of the air.

Table 6 Common Examples of Mists

Type of Coolant/Lubricant	Typical purpose	Secondary purpose	Mist size typical	Other
Water soluble	Cooling	Lubricating (poor)	1 to 10+ μm	Contain paraffins
Straight Oil (neat)	Lubricating	Cooling (poor)	0.07 to 5 μm	Easily vaporize
Semi-synthetic	Cooling	Cooling	1 to 10+ μm	Water-soluble oil and synthetic chemicals
Synthetic	Cooling	Cooling	1 to 10+ μm	Synthetic chemicals Sticky when dried

Mist Types

There are many types of mists that can be filtered, but the most common are water-soluble coolants, straight oil (neat oil), and semi-synthetic and synthetic coolants (Table 6). Each of these have their own specific purpose, whether the process requires cooling, lubrication, or some combination of both. Although mist collectors filter droplets out of the air, it is very common to also be collecting solid particles along with the mist. Most mist collectors can handle some degree of solid particles, but using prefilters is common to improve the efficiency, maintenance cycles, and overall cost of ownership of the mist collector itself.

Applications

There are many different types of industrial applications that mist collectors can be used on, but in general, they can be grouped into cutting, grinding, forming, and casting. Other applications, such as vacuum pumps and pressurized oil reservoirs, require mist collectors as well, but are less common in the industrial market. Each of these applications uses a different type of coolant or lubricant and the nature of the application generates different size mist particles, higher or lower quantities of mist, higher or lower amounts of dust or swarf, and even burnt lubricants that are sometimes referred as burnt hydrocarbons or smoke.

In applications involving processes such as grinding and lathes, removing dust and swarf is important as well as cooling and lubricating. Leftover material after a cut can cause scratching and impurities in the finished surface. Using water-soluble coolants to flush away the leftover material is typically the most economical solutions for these types of applications. On the other hand, where the smallest/finest mist is needed, straight oils are commonly used because these materials can be put under high pressure and sprayed into the smallest of crevices to provide the best lubrication for fine tool work. Unfortunately, straight oils are not good at cooling and, in tight spaces where heat can be the highest, straight oils will vaporize and in some cases burn. Vaporized oil will condense at 0.07 μm and, if time is not allowed for the fine submicron mist to coalesce, it can act as a thermally generated smoke, penetrating the filtration technology and appearing as if the mist collector is not working or on fire. With today's high-efficiency fiber bed filters and final HEPA polishing filters, this tendency has greatly decreased. Most vaporized oil, after coalescing, will increase to an average 0.7 μm, which can be filtered, coalesced further, and finally drip off high-efficiency medias as large droplets.

Each mist collector technology is best suited for a particular type of application and/or mist challenge. Although most filtration technologies will work for any type of mist, the cost of ownership will be greatly different between the different solutions.

2.6 PARTICULATE SCRUBBERS (WET COLLECTORS)

Wet-type dust collectors use liquid (usually, but not necessarily, water) to capture and separate particulate matter (dust, mist, and fumes) from a gas stream. Some scrubbers operate by spraying the **scrubbing liquid** into the contaminated air. Others bubble air through the scrubbing liquid. In addition, many hybrid designs exist.

Particle sizes, which can be controlled by a wet scrubber, range from 0.3 to 50 μm or larger. Wet collectors can be classified into three categories: (1) **low-energy** (up to 2 kJ/m^3, 0.25 to 1.5 kPa); (2) **medium-energy** (2 to 6 kJ/m^3, 1.5 to 4.5 kPa); and (3) **high-energy** (> 6 kJ/m^3, > 4.5 kPa). Typical wet-scrubber performance is summarized in Table 2.

Wet collectors may be used for collection of most particulates from industrial process gas streams where economics allow for collection of the material in a wet state.

Advantages of wet collectors include

- Constant operating pressure
- No secondary dust sources
- Small spare parts requirement
- Ability to collect both gases and particulates
- Ability to handle high-temperature and high-humidity gas streams, as well as to reduce the possibility of fire or explosion
- Reasonably small space requirements for scrubbers
- Ability to continuously collect sticky and hygroscopic solids without becoming fouled

Disadvantages include

- High susceptibility to corrosion (corrosion-resistant construction is expensive)
- High humidity in discharge gas stream, which may give rise to visible and sometimes objectionable fog plumes, particularly during winter
- Large pressure drops and high power requirement for most designs that can efficiently collect fine (particularly submicrometre) particles
- Possible difficulty or high cost of disposal of waste water or clarification waste
- Rapidly decreasing fractional efficiency for most scrubbers for particles less than 1 μm in size
- Freeze protection required in many applications in colder environments

Principle of Operation

The more important mechanisms involved in the capture and removal of particulate matter in scrubbers are inertial impaction, Brownian diffusion, and condensation.

Inertial impaction occurs when a dust particle and a liquid droplet collide, resulting in the capture of the particle. The resulting liquid/dust particle is relatively large and may be easily removed from the carrier gas stream by gravitation or impingement on separators.

Brownian diffusion occurs when the dust particles are extremely small and have motion independent of the carrier gas stream. These small particles collide with one another, making larger particles, or collide with a liquid droplet and are captured.

Condensation occurs when the gas or air is cooled below its dew point. When moisture is condensed from the gas stream, fogging occurs, and the dust particles serve as condensation nuclei. The dust particles become larger as a result of the condensed liquid, and the probability of their removal by impaction is increased.

Wet collectors perform two individual operations. The first occurs in the **contact zone**, where the dirty gas comes in contact with the liquid; the second is in the **separation zone**, where the liquid that has captured the particulate matter is removed from the gas

stream. All well-designed wet collectors use one or more of the following principles:

- High liquid-to-gas ratio
- Intimate contact between the liquid and dust particles, which may be accomplished by forming large numbers of small liquid droplets or by breaking up the gas flow into many small bubbles that are driven through a bath of scrubbing liquid, to increase the chances that contaminants will be wetted and collected
- Abrupt transition from dry to wet zones to avoid particle build-up where dry gas enters the collectors

For a given type of wet collector, the greater the power applied to the system, the higher the collection efficiency will be (Lapple and Kamack 1955). This is the contacting power theory. Figure 15 compares the fractional efficiencies of several wet collectors, and Figure 16 shows the relationship between the pressure drop across a venturi scrubber and the abatement of particulate matter.

Spray Towers and Impingement Scrubbers

Spray towers and impingement scrubbers are available in many different arrangements. The gas stream may be subjected to a single spray or a series of sprays, or the gas may be forced to impinge on a series of irrigated baffles. Except for packed towers, these types of scrubbers are in the low-energy category; thus, they have relatively low particulate removal efficiency. A typical spray tower and an impingement scrubber are illustrated in Figures 17 and 18, respectively.

The efficiency of a spray tower can be improved by adding high-pressure sprays. A spray tower efficiency of 50 to 75% can be improved to 95 to 99% (for dust particles with size near 2 µm) by pressures in the range of 200 to 700 kPa (gage).

Centrifugal-Type Collectors

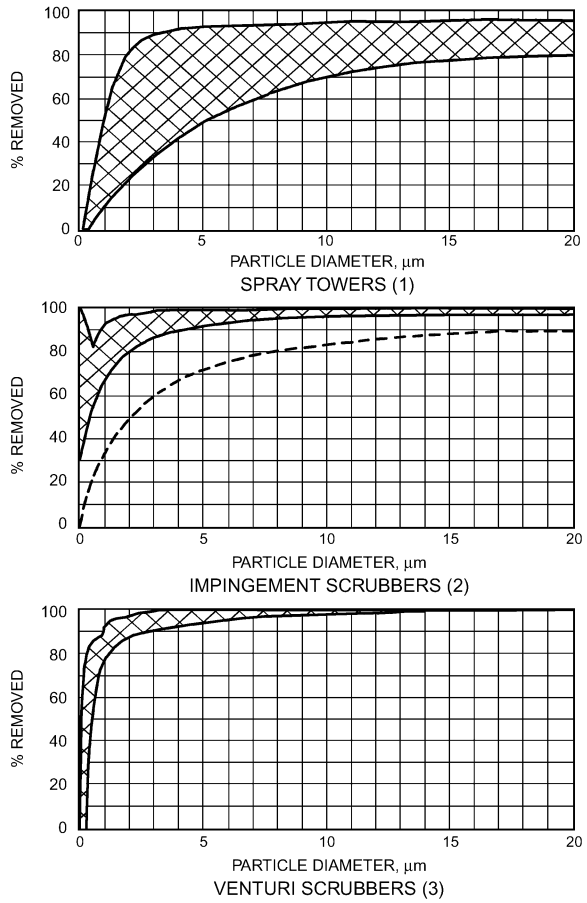
These collectors are characterized by a tangential entry of the gas stream into the collector. They are classed with medium-energy scrubbers. The impingement scrubber shown in Figure 18 is an example of a centrifugal-type wet collector.

Orifice-Type Collectors

Orifice-type collectors are also classified in the medium-energy category. Usually, the gas stream is made to impinge on the surface of the scrubbing liquid and is forced through constrictions where the gas velocity is increased and where the liquid/gaseous/particulate interaction occurs. Water usage for orifice collectors is limited to evaporation loss and removal of collected pollutants. A typical orifice-type wet collector is illustrated in Figure 19.

Venturi Scrubber

A high-energy venturi scrubber passes the gas through a venturi-shaped orifice where the gas is accelerated to 60 m/s or more.



Notes:
1. Efficiency depends on liquid distribution.
2. Upper curve is for packed tower; lower curve is for orifice-type wet collector. Dashed lines indicate performance of low-efficiency, irrigated baffles or rods.
3. Efficiency is directly related to fluid rate and pressure drop.

Fig. 15 Fractional Efficiency of Several Wet Collectors

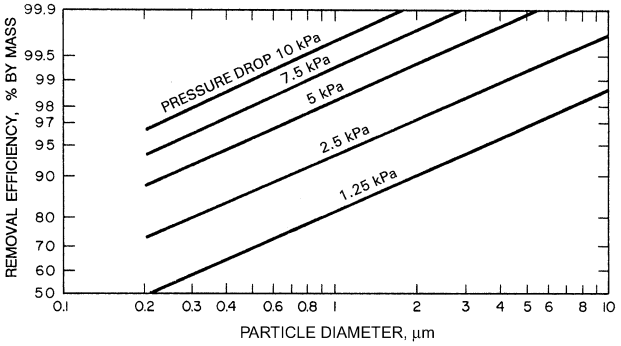


Fig. 16 Efficiency of Venturi Scrubber

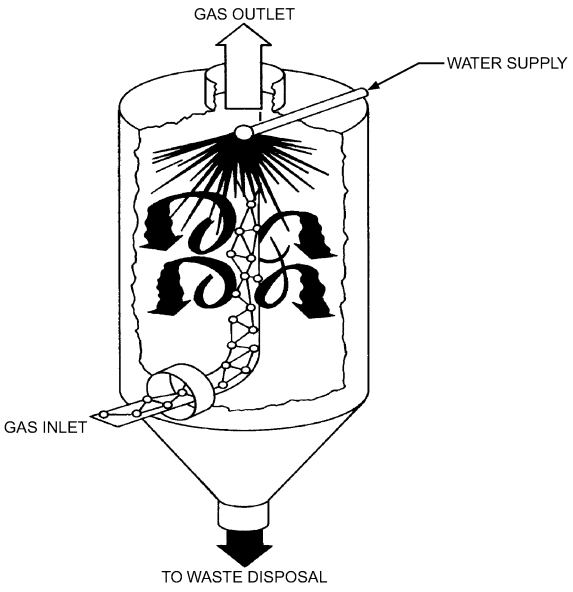


Fig. 17 Typical Spray Tower

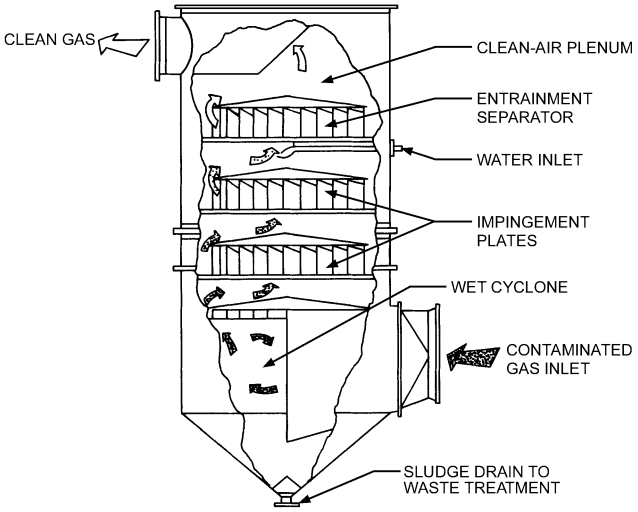


Fig. 18 Typical Impingement Scrubber

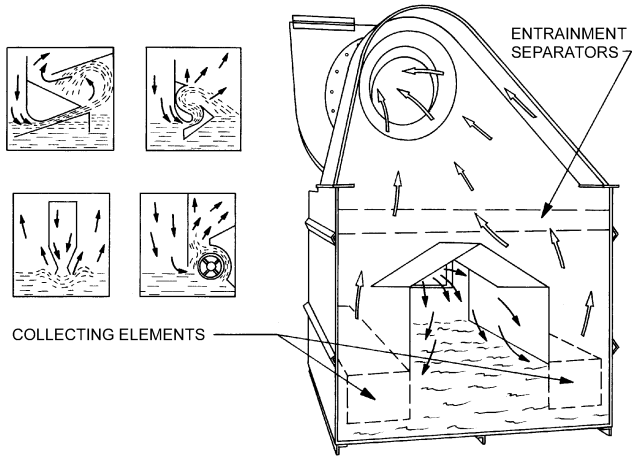


Fig. 19 Typical Orifice-Type Wet Collector

Depending on the design, the scrubbing liquid is added at, or ahead of, the throat. The rapid acceleration of the gas shears the liquid into a fine mist, increasing the chance of liquid-particle impaction. Yung has developed a mathematical model for the performance and design of venturi scrubbers (Semrau 1977). Subsequent validation experiments (Rudnick et al. 1986) demonstrated that this model yields a more representative prediction of venturi scrubber performance than other performance models do.

In typical applications, the pressure drop for gases across a venturi is higher than for other types of scrubber. Water circulation is also higher; thus, venturi systems use water reclamation systems. One example of a venturi scrubber is illustrated in Figure 20.

Electrostatically Augmented Scrubbers

Several gas-cleaning devices combine electrical charging of particulate matter with wet scrubbing. Electrostatic augmentation enhances fine particle control by causing an electrical attraction between the particles and the liquid droplets. Compared to venturi scrubbers, electrostatically augmented scrubbers remove particles smaller than 1 μm at a much lower pressure drop.

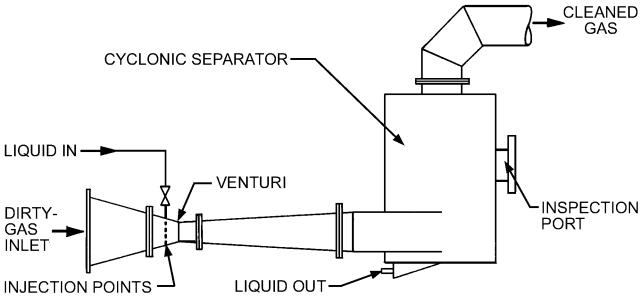


Fig. 20 Typical High-Energy Venturi Scrubber

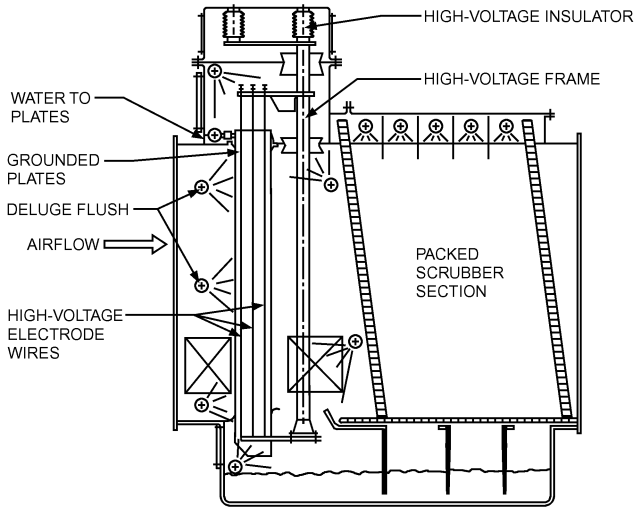


Fig. 21 Typical Electrostatically Augmented Scrubber

There are three generic designs for electrostatic augmentation:

1. Unipolar charged aerosols pass through a contact chamber containing randomly oriented packing elements of dielectric material. A typical electrostatically augmented scrubber of this design is shown in Figure 21.
2. Unipolar charged aerosols pass through a low-energy venturi scrubber.
3. Unipolar charged aerosols pass into a spray chamber where they are attracted to oppositely charged liquid droplets.

Collection efficiencies of 50 to 90% can be achieved in a single particle charging and collection stage, depending on the mass loading of fine particles and the superficial velocity of gases in the collector. Higher collection efficiencies can be obtained by using two or more stages. Removal efficiency of gaseous pollutants depends on the mass transfer and absorption design of the scrubber section.

In most applications of electrostatically augmented scrubbers, the dirty gas stream is quenched by adiabatic cooling with liquid sprays; thus, it contains a large amount of water vapor that wets the particulate contaminants. This moisture provides a dominant influence on particle adhesion and the electrical resistivity of deposits in the collector.

Electrical equipment for particle charging is similar to that for electrostatic precipitators. The scrubber section is usually equipped with a liquid recycle pump, recycle piping, and a liquid distribution system.

3. GASEOUS CONTAMINANT CONTROL

Many industrial processes produce large quantities of gaseous or vaporized contaminants that must be separated from gas streams. These contaminants are usually removed through absorption into a liquid or adsorption onto a solid medium. Incineration of exhaust gas (see the section on Incineration of Gases and Vapors) has also been successfully used to remove organic gases and vapors. Low-vapor-pressure odorous materials that condense to form submicrometre condensation aerosols after being emitted from hot industrial processes can sometimes be successfully controlled by well-designed condensing filter or condensing precipitator submicrometre particulate collection systems (see the section on Two-Stage Designs under Electrostatic Precipitators).

3.1 SPRAY DRY SCRUBBING

Spray dry scrubbing is used to absorb and neutralize acidic gaseous contaminants in hot industrial gas streams. The system uses an alkali spray to react with the acid gases to form a salt. The process heat evaporates the liquid, resulting in a dry particulate that is removed from the gas stream.

Typical industrial applications of spray dry scrubbing are

- Control of hydrochloric acid (HCl) emissions from biological hazardous-waste incinerators
- Control of sulfuric acid and sulfur trioxide emissions from burning high-sulfur coal
- Control of sulfur oxides (SO_x), boric acid, and hydrogen fluoride (HF) gases from glass-melting furnaces.

Principle of Operation

Spray drying involves four operations: (1) atomization, (2) gas droplet mixing, (3) drying of liquid droplets, and (4) removal and collection of a dry product. These operations are carried out in a tower or a specially designed vessel.

In any spray dryer design, good mixing and efficient gas droplet contact are desirable. Dryer height is largely determined by the time required to dry the largest droplets produced by the atomizer. Towers used for acid gas control typically have gas residence times of about 10 s, compared to about 3 s for towers designed for evaporative cooling. The longer residence time is needed because drying by itself is not the primary goal for the equipment. Many of the acid/alkali reactions are accelerated in the liquid state. It is, therefore, desirable to cool the gases to as close as possible to the adiabatic saturation temperature (dew point) without risking condensation in downstream particulate collectors. At these low temperatures, droplets survive against evaporation much longer, thus obtaining a better chance of contacting all acidic contaminants while the alkali compounds are in their most reactive state.

Equipment

The **atomizer** must disperse a liquid containing an alkali compound that will react with acidic components of the gas stream. The liquid must be distributed uniformly in the dryer and mixed thoroughly with the hot gases in droplets of a size that will evaporate before striking a dryer surface.

In typical spray dryers used for acid gas control, the droplets have diameters ranging from 50 to 200 μm. The larger droplets are of most concern because these might survive long enough to impinge on equipment surfaces. In general, a tradeoff must be made between the largest amount of liquid that can be sprayed and the largest droplets that can be tolerated by the equipment. The angular distribution or **fan-out** of the spray is also important. In spray drying, the angle is often 60 to 80°, although both lower and higher angles are sometimes required. The fan-out may change with distance from the nozzle, especially at high pressures.

An important aspect of spray dryer design and operation is the production and control of the gas flow patterns in the drying chamber. Because of the importance of the flow patterns, spray dryers are usually classified on the basis of gas flow direction in the chamber relative to the spray. There are three basic designs: (1) **cocurrent**, in which the liquid feed is sprayed with the flow of the hot gas; (2) **countercurrent**, in which the feed is sprayed against the flow of the gas; and (3) **mixed flow**, in which there is a combined cocurrent and countercurrent flow.

There are several types of atomizers. High-speed rotating **disks** achieve atomization through centrifugal motion. Although disks are bulky and relatively expensive, they are also more flexible than nozzles in compensating for changes in particle size caused by variations in feed characteristics. Disks are also used when high-pressure feed systems are not available. They are frequently used when high volumes of liquid must be spray dried. Disks are not well suited to counterflow or horizontal flow dryers.

Nozzles are also commonly used. These may be subdivided into two distinct types: centrifugal pressure nozzles and two-fluid (or pneumatic) nozzles. In the **centrifugal pressure nozzle**, energy for atomization is supplied solely by the pressure of the feed liquid. Most pressure nozzles are of the swirl type, in which tangential inlets or slots spin the liquid in the nozzle. The pressure nozzle satisfactorily atomizes liquids with viscosities of 300 mPa·s or higher. It is well suited to counterflow spray dryers and to installations requiring multiple atomizers. Capacities up to 1.3 kg/s through a single nozzle are possible. Pressure nozzles have some disadvantages. For example, pressure, capacity, and orifice size are independent, resulting in a certain degree of inflexibility. Moreover, pressure nozzles (particularly those with small passages) are susceptible to erosion in applications involving abrasive materials. In such instances, tungsten carbide or a similarly tough material is mandatory.

In **two-fluid nozzles**, air (or steam) supplies most of the energy required to atomize the liquid. Liquid, admitted under low pressure, may be mixed with the air either internally or externally. Although energy requirements for this atomizer are generally greater than for spinning disks or pressure nozzles, the two-fluid nozzle can produce very fine atomization, particularly with viscous materials.

The density and viscosity of the feed materials and how these might change at elevated temperature should be considered. Some alkali compounds do not form a solution at the concentrations needed for acid gas control. It is not uncommon that pumps and nozzles must be chosen to handle and meter slurries.

Spray dryer systems include metering valves, pumps and compressors, and controls to ensure optimal chemical feed and temperature in the gas-cleaning system.

3.2 WET-PACKED SCRUBBERS

Packed scrubbers are used to remove gaseous and particulate contaminants from gas streams. Scrubbing is accomplished by impingement of particulate matter and/or by absorption of soluble gas or vapor molecules on the liquid-wetted surface of the packing. There is no limit to the amount of particulate capture, as long as the properties of the liquid film are unchanged.

Gas or vapor removal is more complex than particulate capture. The contaminant becomes a solute and has a vapor pressure above that of the scrubbing liquid. This vapor pressure typically increases with increasing concentration of the solute in the liquid and/or with increasing liquid temperature. Contaminant scrubbing continues as long as the partial pressure of contaminant in the gas is above its vapor pressure with respect to the liquid. The rate of contaminant removal is a function of the difference between the partial pressure and vapor pressure, as well as the rate of diffusion of the contaminant.

In most common gas-scrubbing operations, small increases in the superficial velocity of gases through the collector decrease the removal efficiency; therefore, these devices are operated at the highest possible superficial velocities consistent with acceptable contaminant control. Usually, increasing the liquid rate has little effect on efficiency; therefore, liquid flow is kept near the minimum required for satisfactory operation and removal of particulate matter. As the superficial velocity of gases in the collector increases above a certain value, there is a tendency to strip liquid from the surface of the packing and entrain the liquid from the scrubber. If pressure drop is not the limiting factor for operation of the equipment, maximum scrubbing capacity occurs at a gas rate just below the rate that causes excessive liquid reentrainment.

Scrubber Packings

Packings are designed to present a large surface area that will wet evenly with liquid. They should also have high void ratio so that pressure drop will be low. High-efficiency packings promote turbulent mixing of the gas and liquid. Figure 22 illustrates six types of packings that are randomly dumped into scrubbers. Packings are available in ceramic, metal, and thermoplastic materials. Plastic packings are extensively used in scrubbers because of their low mass and resistance to mechanical damage. They offer a wide range of chemical resistance to acids, alkalies, and many organic compounds; however, plastic packing can be deformed by excessive temperatures or by solvent attack.

The relative capacity of tower packings at constant pressure drop can be obtained by calculation from the **packing factor *F***. The gas-handling capacity G of a packing is inversely proportional to the square root of F:

$$G = K/\sqrt{F} \tag{8}$$

where

G = mass flow rate of gases through scrubber
F = packing factor (surface area of packing per unit volume of gently poured material)

The smaller the packing factor of a given packing, the greater will be its gas-handling capacity. Typical packing factors for scrubber packings are summarized in Table 7.

Arrangements of Packed Scrubbers

The four generic arrangements for wet-packed scrubbers are illustrated in Figure 23:

- Horizontal cocurrent scrubber
- Vertical cocurrent scrubber
- Cross-flow scrubber
- Countercurrent scrubber

Cocurrent flow scrubbers can be operated with either horizontal or vertical gas and liquid flows. A **horizontal cocurrent scrubber** depends on the gas velocity to carry the liquid into the packed bed. It operates as a wetted entrainment separator with limited gas and liquid contact time. The superficial velocity of gases in the collector is limited by liquid reentrainment to about 3.3 m/s. A **vertical cocurrent scrubber** can be operated at very high pressure drop (800 to 2450 Pa per metre of packing depth) because there is no flooding limit for the superficial velocity. The contact time in a cocurrent scrubber is a function of bed depth. The effectiveness of absorption processes is lower in cocurrent scrubbers than in the

Table 7 Packing Factor *F* for Various Scrubber Packing Materials

		Nominal Size, mm				
Type of Packing	**Material**	**20**	**25**	**40**	**50**	**80 or 90**
Saddles, scalloped-edge	Plastic		40		21	16
Saddles, scalloped-edge	Ceramic		60		30	
Saddles	Ceramic	145	92	52	40	22
Saddles, perforated extended	Plastic				32	21
Berl saddles	Ceramic	170	110	65	45	
Raschig rings	Ceramic	255	155	95	65	37
Perforated rings	Metal		48	33	20	16
Perforated rings	Plastic		52	40	24	16
Large perforated rings	Metal		43	26	18	15
Toroidal helix	Plastic		36		18	16

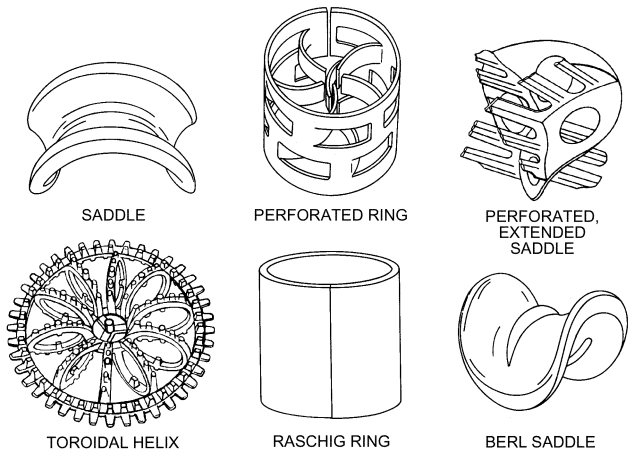


Fig. 22 Typical Packings for Scrubbers

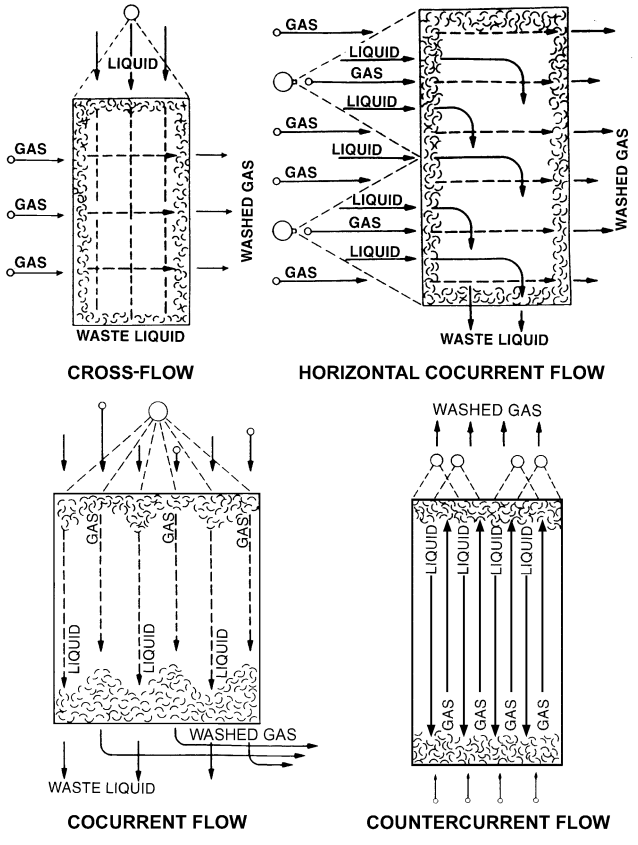


Fig. 23 Flow Arrangements Through Packed Beds

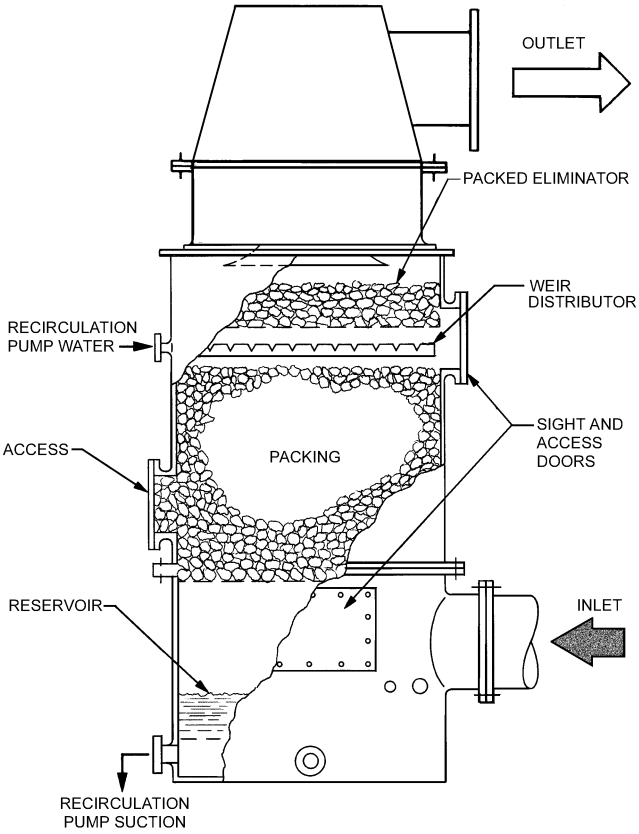


Fig. 24 Typical Countercurrent Packed Scrubber

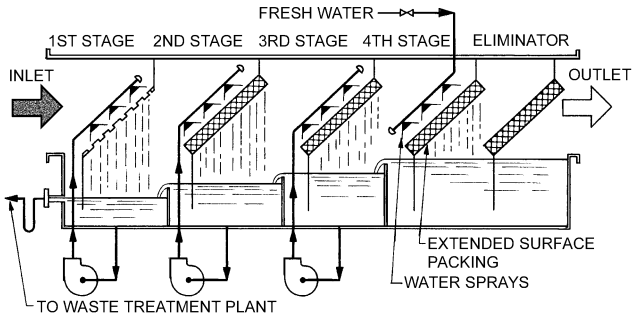


Fig. 25 Horizontal Flow Scrubber with Extended Surface

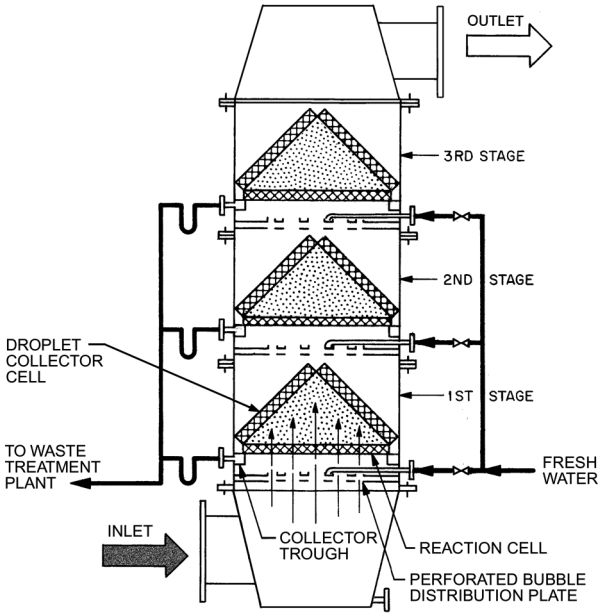


Fig. 26 Vertical Flow Scrubber with Extended Surface

other arrangements because the liquid containing contaminant is in contact with the exit gas stream.

Cross-flow scrubbers use downward-flowing liquid and a horizontally moving gas stream. The effectiveness of absorption processes in cross-flow scrubbers lies between those for cocurrent and countercurrent flow scrubbers.

Countercurrent scrubbers use a downward-flowing liquid and an upward-flowing gas. The gas-handling capacity of countercurrent scrubbers is limited by pressure drop or by liquid entrainment. Contact time can be controlled by the depth of packing used. The effectiveness of absorption processes is maximized because the exiting gas is in contact with fresh scrubbing liquid.

The most broadly used arrangement is the countercurrent packed scrubber. This type of scrubber, illustrated in Figure 24, gives the best removal of gaseous contaminants while keeping liquid consumption to a minimum. The effluent liquid has the highest contaminant concentration.

Extended-surface packings have been used successfully for the absorption of highly soluble gases such as HCl because the required contact time is minimal. This type of packing consists of a woven mat of fine fibers of a plastic material that is not affected by chemical exposure. Figure 25 shows an example of a scrubber consisting of three wetted stages of extended surface packing in series with the gas flow. A final dry mat is used as an entrainment eliminator. If solids are present in the inlet gas stream, a wetted impingement stage precedes the wetted mats to prevent plugging of the woven mats.

Figure 26 shows a scrubber with a vertical arrangement of extended surface packing. This design uses three complete stages in series with the gas flow. The horizontal mat at the bottom of each stage operates as a flooded bed scrubber. The flooded bed is used to minimize water consumption. The two inclined upper mats operate as entrainment eliminators.

Pressure Drop

The pressure drop through a particular packing in countercurrent scrubbers can be calculated from the airflow and water flow per unit area. Charts, such as the one shown in Figure 27, are available from manufacturers of each type and size of packing.

The pressure drop for any packing can also be estimated by using the data on packing factors in Table 7 and the modified generalized pressure drop correlation shown in Figure 28. This correlation was developed for a gas stream substantially of air, with water as the scrubbing liquid. It should not be used if the properties of the gas or liquid vary significantly from air or water, respectively. Countercurrent scrubbers are generally designed to operate at pressure drops between 200 and 530 Pa per metre of packing depth. Liquid irrigation rates typically vary between 3.4 and 13.6 L/s per square metre of bed area.

Absorption Efficiency

The prediction of the absorption efficiency of a packed bed scrubber is much more complex than estimating its capacity because performance estimates involve the mechanics of absorption.

Some of the factors affecting efficiency are superficial velocity of gases in the scrubber, liquid injection rate, packing size, type of packing, amount of contaminant to be removed, distribution and amount of absorbent available for reaction, temperature, and reaction rate for absorption.

Practically all commercial packings have been tested for absorption rate (mass transfer coefficient) using standard absorber conditions: carbon dioxide (CO_2) in air and a solution of caustic soda (NaOH) in water. This system was selected because the interaction of the variables is well understood. Further, the mass transfer coefficients for this system are low; thus, they can be determined accurately by experiment. The values of mass transfer coefficients ($K_G\,a$) for various packings under these standard test conditions are given in Table 8.

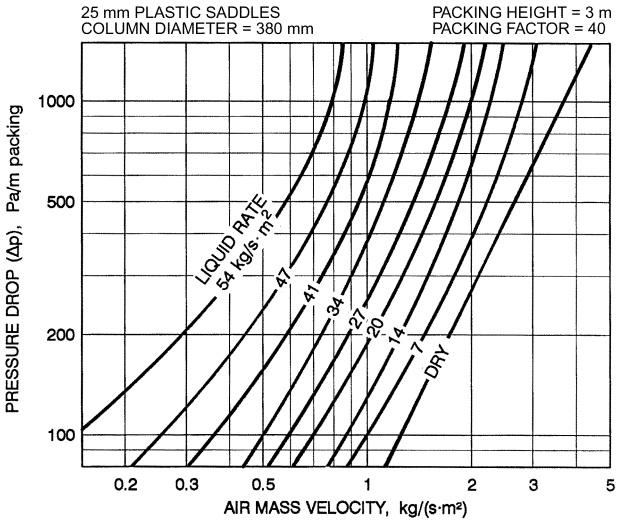


Fig. 27 Pressure Drop Versus Gas Rate for Typical Packing

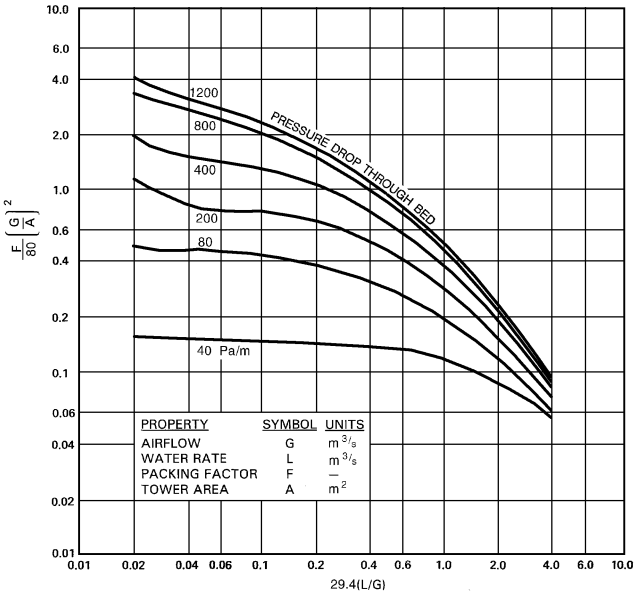


Fig. 28 Generalized Pressure Drop Curves for Packed Beds

The vast majority of wet absorbers are used to control low concentrations (less than 0.005 mole fraction) of contaminants in air. Dilute aqueous solutions of NaOH are usually chosen as the scrubbing fluid. These conditions simplify the design of scrubbers somewhat. Mass transfer from the gas to the liquid is then explained by the **two-film theory**: the gaseous contaminant travels by diffusion from the main gas stream through the gas film, then through the liquid film, and finally into the main liquid stream. The relative influences of the gas and liquid films on the absorption rate depend on the contaminant's solubility in the liquid. Sparingly soluble gases like hydrogen sulfide (H_2S) and CO_2 are said to be liquid-film-controlled; highly soluble gases such as HCl and ammonia (NH_3) are said to be gas-film-controlled. In liquid-film-controlled systems, the mass transfer coefficient varies with the liquid injection rate but is only slightly affected by the superficial velocity of the gases. In gas-film-controlled systems, the mass transfer coefficient is a function of both the superficial velocity of the gases and the liquid injection rate.

In the absence of leakage, the percentage by volume of the contaminant removed from the air can be found from the inlet and outlet concentrations of contaminant in the airstream:

$$\%\ \text{Removed} = 100(1 - Y_o/Y_i) \tag{9}$$

where

Y_i = mole fraction of contaminants entering scrubber (dry gas basis)
Y_o = mole fraction of contaminants exiting scrubber (dry gas basis)

The driving pressure for absorption (assuming negligible vapor pressure above the liquid) is controlled by the logarithmic mean of inlet and outlet concentrations of the contaminant:

$$\Delta p_{\ln} = p\frac{Y_i - Y_o}{\ln(Y_i/Y_o)} \tag{10}$$

where

$\Delta p_{\ln}$ = driving or diffusion pressure acting to absorb contaminants on packing
p = inlet pressure

The rate of absorption of contaminant (mass transfer coefficient) is related to the depth of packing as follows:

$$K_G a = N/HA\Delta p_{\ln} \tag{11}$$

where

N = solute absorbed, mol/s
H = depth of packing, m
A = cross-sectional area of scrubber, m^2

The value of N can be determined from

$$N = G(1 - Y_i - Y_o) \tag{12}$$

where G = mass flow rate of gases through scrubber, mol/s.

Table 8 Mass Transfer Coefficients ($K_G\,a$) for Scrubber Packing Materials

Type of Packing	Material	Nominal Size, mm			
		25	40	50	80 or 90
		$K_G a$, mol/(s·m³·kPa)			
Scalloped saddles	Plastic	0.096		0.063	0.039
Saddles	Ceramic	0.086	0.075	0.063	0.036
Perforated extended saddles	Plastic			0.063	0.039
Raschig rings	Ceramic	0.076	0.066	0.053	
Perforated rings	Metal	0.102	0.082	0.071	0.040
Perforated rings	Plastic	0.087	0.076	0.064	0.039
Large perforated rings	Metal	0.097	0.082	0.074	0.048
Toroidal helix	Plastic	0.096		0.087	

System: CO_2 and NaOH; gas rate: 0.67 kg/(m²·s); liquid rate: 2.7 kg/(m²·s).

The superficial velocity of gases is a function of the unit gas flow rate and the gas density:

$$V = TGM_v/C_1A \quad (13)$$

where

V = superficial gas velocity, m/s
M_v = molar volume, m^3/mol
T = exit gas temperature, K = °C + 273
C_1 = 273 K

By combining these equations and assuming ambient pressure, a graphical solution can be derived for both liquid-film- and gas-film-controlled systems. Figures 29, 30, and 31 show the height of packing required versus percent removal for various mass transfer coefficients at superficial velocities of 0.6, 1.2, and 1.8 m/s, respectively, with liquid-film-controlled systems. Figures 32, 33, and 34 show the height of packing versus percent removal for various mass transfer coefficients at the same three superficial velocities with gas film-controlled systems.

These graphs can be used to determine the height of 50 mm plastic saddles (see Figure 22) required to give the desired percentage of contaminant removal. The height for any other type or size of packing is inversely proportional to the ratio of standard $K_G a$ taken from Table 8. Thus, if 4.0 m packing depth were required for 95% removal of contaminants, the same efficiency could be obtained with a 2.9 m depth of 25 mm plastic perforated rings (Figure 22), at the same superficial velocity and liquid injection rate. However, the pressure drop would be higher for the smaller-diameter packing.

Figures 29 to 34 are useful when the value of the mass transfer coefficient for the particular contaminant to be removed is known. Table 9 contains mass transfer coefficients for 50 mm plastic scalloped saddles in typical liquid-film-controlled scrubbers. These values can be compared with the mass transfer coefficients in Table 10 for the same packing used in gas-film-controlled scrubbers. When the scrubbing liquid is not water, the mass transfer coefficients in these tables can only be used if the amount of reagent in the solution exceeds by at least 33% the amount needed to completely absorb the gaseous contaminant.

When HCl is dissolved in water, there is little vapor pressure of HCl above solutions of less than 8% (by mass) concentration. On the other hand, when NH_3 is dissolved in water, there is an appreciable vapor pressure of NH_3 above solutions, even at low concentrations. The height of packing needed for NH_3 removal, obtained from Figures 32 to 34, is based on the use of dilute acid to maintain the pH of the solution below 7.

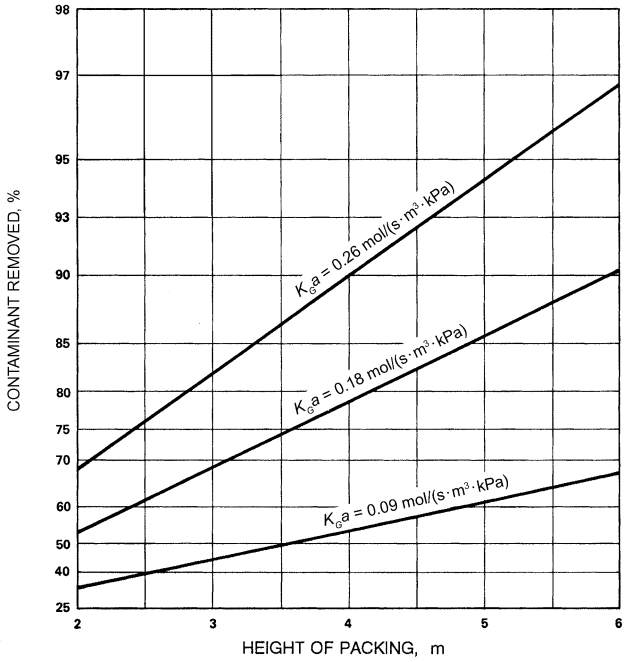


Fig. 30 Contaminant Control at Superficial Velocity = 1.2 m/s (Liquid-Film-Controlled)

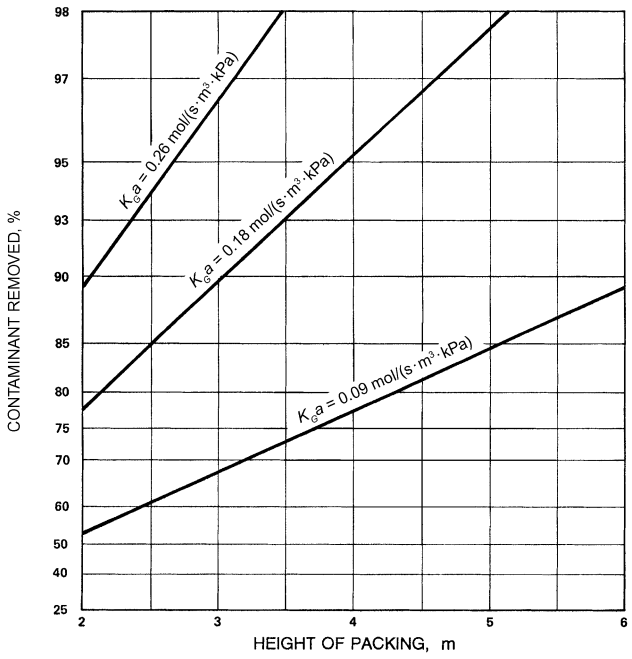


Fig. 29 Contaminant Control at Superficial Velocity = 0.6 m/s (Liquid-Film-Controlled)

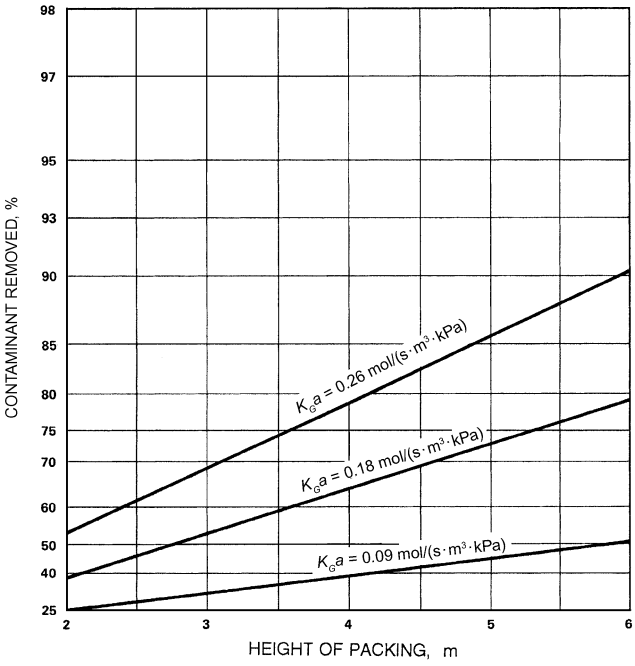


Fig. 31 Contaminant Control at Superficial Velocity = 1.8 m/s (Liquid-Film-Controlled)

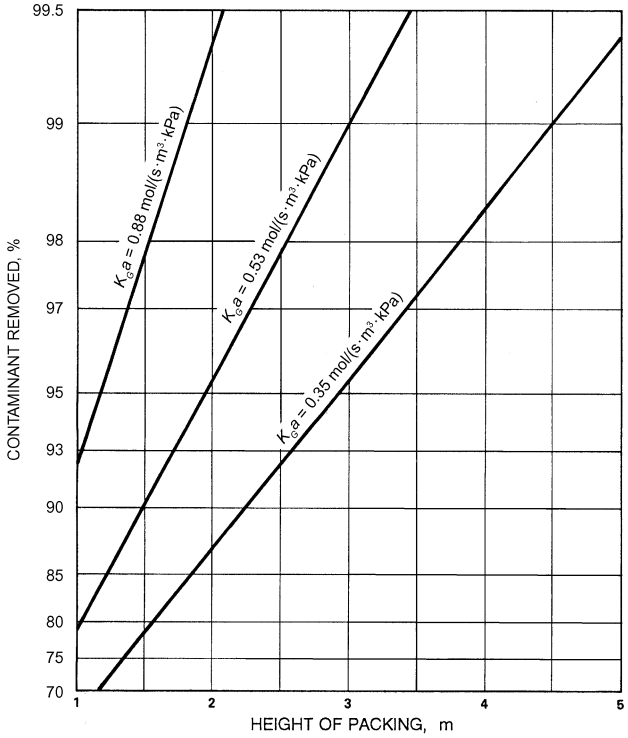


Fig. 32 Contaminant Control at Superficial Velocity = 0.6 m/s (Gas-Film-Controlled)

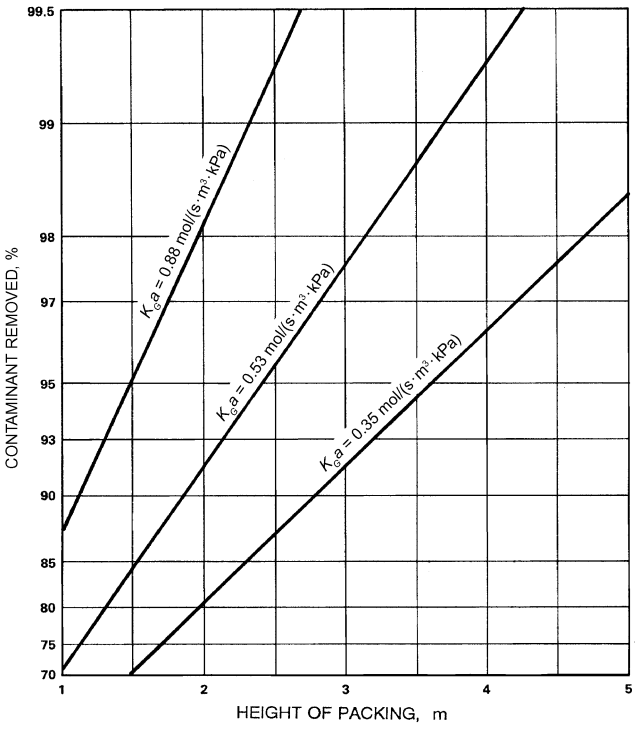


Fig. 33 Contaminant Control at Superficial Velocity = 1.2 m/s (Gas-Film-Controlled)

The following is an example of a typical scrubbing problem.

Example 1. Remove 95% of the HF from air at 30°C. The concentration of HF is 0.0006 mole fraction on a dry gas basis. The concentration of HF in the exhaust gas should not exceed 0.000 030 mole fraction.

The following design conditions apply:

Total volumetric flow of gas G = 2 m³/s
Liquid injection rate = 0.0025 m/s

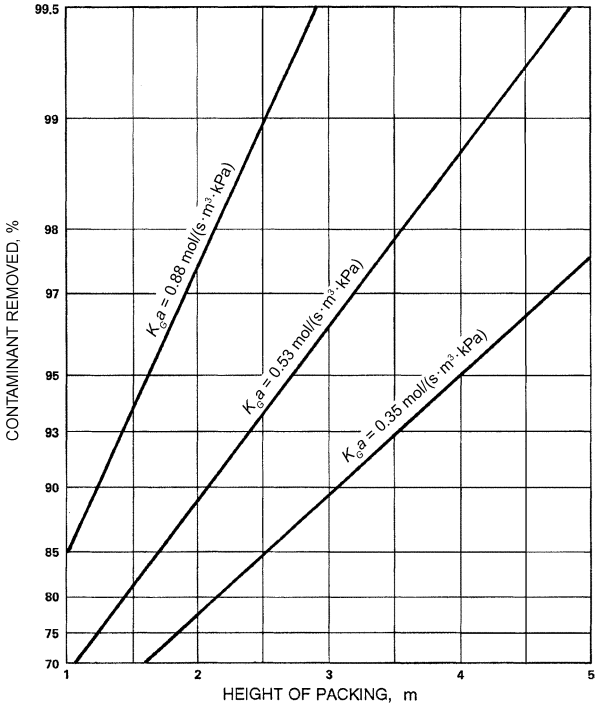


Fig. 34 Contaminant Control at Superficial Velocity = 1.8 m/s (Gas-Film-Controlled)

Table 9 Relative K_Ga for Various Contaminants in Liquid-Film-Controlled Scrubbers

Gas Contaminant	Scrubbing Liquid	K_Ga, mol/(s·m³·kPa)
CO_2	4% (by mass) NaOH	0.088
H_2S	4% (by mass) NaOH	0.26
SO_2	Water	0.13
HCN	Water	0.26
HCHO	Water	0.26
Cl_2	Water	0.2

Note: Data for50 mm plastic scalloped saddles. Temperatures: from 16 to 24°C; liquid rate: 6.8 L/(s·m²); gas rate: 1.1 m/s.

Table 10 Relative K_Ga for Various Contaminants in Gas-Film-Controlled Scrubbers

Gas Contaminant	Scrubbing Liquid	K_Ga, mol/(s·m³·kPa)
HCl	Water	0.82
HBr	Water	0.26
HF	Water	0.35
NH_3	Water	0.76
Cl_2	8% (by mass) NaOH	0.63
SO_2	11% (by mass) Na_2CO_3	0.52
Br_2	5% (by mass) NaOH	0.22

Note: Data for 250 mm plastic scalloped saddles. Temperatures 16 to 24°C; liquid rate: 0.0068 m/s; gas rate: 1.1 m/s.

Liquid temperature = 20°C
Packed tower diameter = 1.5 m
Packing material is 50 mm polypropylene scalloped saddles

Solution:

Cross-sectional area of absorber

$$A = \pi(1.5/2)^2 = 1.77 \text{ m}^2$$

Total liquid flow rate

$$L = 0.0025 \times 1.77 = 0.00442 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$$

Packing factor (from Table 7)

$$F = 21$$

Figure 29 may be used to find the pressure drop through the packed tower:

$$x\text{-axis} = 29.4(L/G) = 0.065$$
$$y\text{-axis} = (F/80)(G/A)^2 = 0.335$$

From Figure 28, the pressure drop is about 65 Pa per metre of packing depth.

From Table 10, $K_G a = 0.35$ for HF. From Figure 33, the depth of packing required for 95% removal is 4 m. Thus, the total pressure drop is 4 × 65 = 260 Pa.

General Efficiency Comparisons

Figure 33 indicates that, with $K_G a = 0.35$, 90% removal of HF could be achieved with 3.1 m of packing; this is 23% less packing than needed for 96% removal. Furthermore, with the same superficial velocity, both liquid-film- and gas-film-controlled systems require a 43% increase in absorbent depth to raise the removal efficiency from 80 to 90%.

A comparison of Figures 32 and 33 shows that increasing the superficial velocity by 50% in a gas-film-controlled scrubber requires only a 12% increase in bed depth to maintain equal removal efficiencies. In the liquid-film-controlled system (Figures 29 and 30), increasing the superficial velocity by 50% requires an approximately 50% increase in bed depth to maintain equal removal efficiencies.

Thus, in a gas-film-controlled system, the superficial velocity can be increased significantly with only a small increase in bed depth required to maintain the efficiency. In practical terms, gas-film-controlled scrubbers of fixed depth can handle an overload condition with only a minor loss of removal efficiency. Performance of liquid-film-controlled scrubbers degrades significantly under similar overload conditions. This occurs because the mass transfer coefficient is independent of superficial velocity.

Liquid Effects

Some liquids tend to foam when they are contaminated with particulates or soluble salts. In these cases, the pressure drop should be kept in the lower half of the normal range: 200 to 330 Pa per metre of packing depth.

In the control of gaseous pollution, most systems do not destroy the pollutant but merely remove it from the air. When water is used as the scrubbing liquid, effluent from the scrubber will contain suspended particulate or dissolved solute. Water treatment is often required to alter the pH and/or remove toxic substances before the solutions can be discharged.

3.3 ADSORPTION OF GASEOUS CONTAMINANTS

The surface of freshly broken or heated solids often contains van der Waals (London dispersion) forces that can physically or chemically adsorb nearby molecules in a gas or liquid. The captured molecules form a thin layer on the surface of the solid that is typically one to three molecules thick. Commercial adsorbents are solids with an enormous internal surface area. This large surface area enables them to capture and hold large numbers of molecules. For example, each gram of a typical activated carbon adsorbent contains over 1000 m^2 of internal surface area. Adsorbents are used for removing organic vapors, water vapor, odors, and hazardous pollutants from gas streams.

The most common adsorbents used in industrial processes include activated carbons, activated alumina, silica gel, and molecular sieves. Activated carbons are derived from coal, wood, or coconut shells. They are primarily selected to remove organic compounds in preference to water. The other three common gas-phase adsorbents have a great affinity for water and adsorb it to the exclusion of any organic molecules also present in a gas stream. They are used primarily as gas-drying agents. Molecular sieves also find use in several specialized pollution control applications, including removal of mercury vapor, sulfur dioxide (SO_2), or nitrogen oxides (NO_x) from gas streams. The capacity of a particular activated carbon to adsorb any organic vapor from mass of the organic compound and the temperature of the gas stream. Compounds with a higherrelative molecular mass are usually more strongly adsorbed than those with lower massThe capacity of activated carbon to adsorb any given organic compound increases with the concentration of that compound. Reducing the temperature also favors adsorption. Typical adsorption capacities of an activated carbon for toluene (relative molecular mass 92) and acetone (relative molecular mass 58) are illustrated in Figure 35 for various temperatures and concentrations.

Regeneration. Adsorption is reversible. An increase in temperature causes some or all of an adsorbed vapor to desorb. The temperature of low-pressure steam is sufficient to drive off most of a low-boiling-point organic compound previously adsorbed at ambient temperature. Higher-boiling-point organic compounds may require high-pressure steam or hot inert gas to secure good desorption. Compounds with a very highrelative molecular mass can require reactivation of the carbon adsorber in a furnace at 750°C to drive off all the adsorbed material. Regeneration of the carbon adsorbers can also be accomplished, in some instances, by washing with an aqueous solution of a chemical that will react with the adsorbed organic material, making it water soluble. An example is washing carbon containing adsorbed sulfur compounds with NaOH.

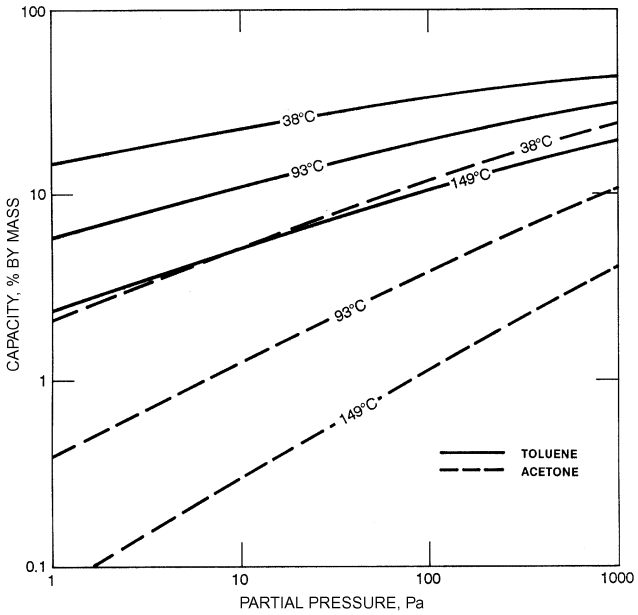


Fig. 35 Adsorption Isotherms on Activated Carbon

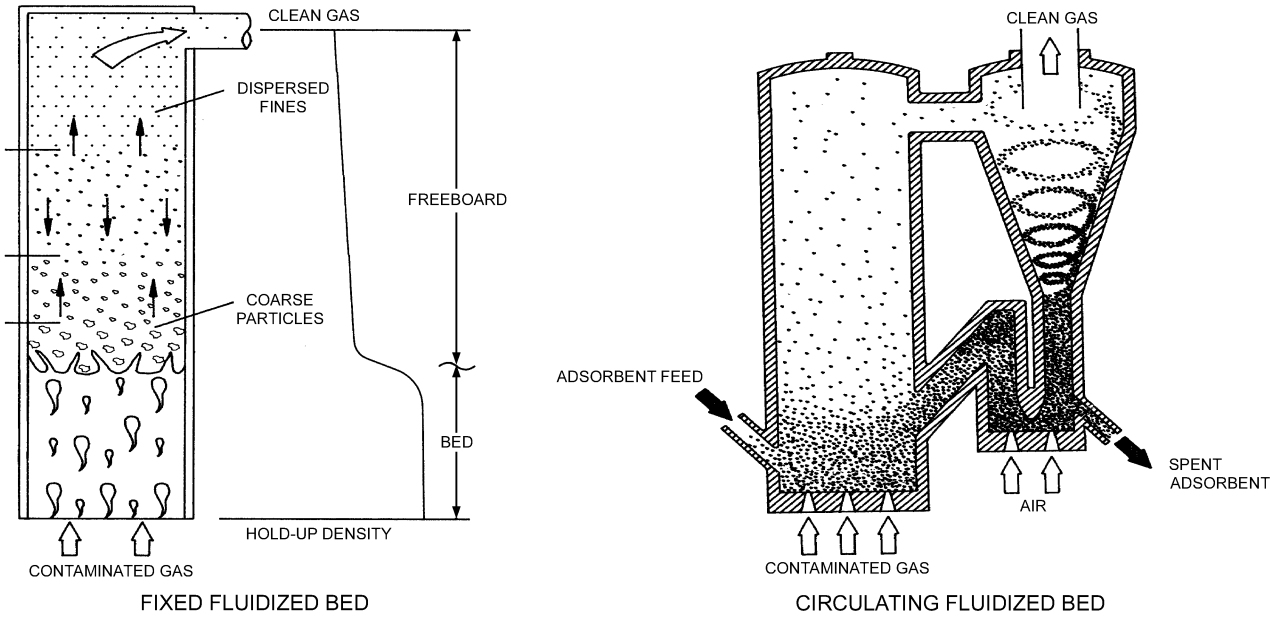


Fig. 36 Fluidized-Bed Adsorption Equipment

The difference between an adsorbent's capacity under adsorbing and desorbing conditions in any application is its **working capacity**. Activated carbon for air pollution control is found in canisters under the hoods of most automobiles. The adsorber in these canisters captures gasoline vapors escaping from fuel aspiration devices (when the engine is stopped) and from the fuel tank's breather vent. Gasoline vapors are desorbed by pulling fresh air through the carbon canister and into the carburetor when the engine is running. Although there is no temperature difference between adsorbing and desorbing conditions in this case, the outdoor airflow desorbs enough gasoline vapors to give the carbon a substantial working capacity.

For applications where only traces of a pollutant must be removed from exhaust air, the life of a carbon bed is very long. In these cases, it is often more economical to replace the carbon than to invest in regeneration equipment. Larger quantities can be returned to the carbon manufacturer for high-temperature thermal reactivation. Regeneration in place by steam, hot inert gas, or washing with a solution of alkali is sometimes practiced.

Impregnated (chemically reactive) adsorbents are used when physical adsorption alone is too weak to remove a particular gaseous contaminant from an industrial gas stream. Through impregnation, the reactive chemical is spread over the immense internal surface area of an adsorbent.

Typical applications of impregnated adsorbent include the following:

- Sulfur- or iodine-impregnated carbon removes mercury vapor from air, hydrogen, or other gases by forming mercuric sulfide or iodide.
- Metal oxide-impregnated carbons remove hydrogen sulfide.
- Amine- or iodine-impregnated carbons and silver exchanged zeolites remove radioactive methyl iodide from nuclear power plant work areas and exhaust gases.
- Alkali-impregnated carbons remove acid gases.
- Activated alumina impregnated with potassium permanganate removes acrolein and formaldehyde.

Equipment for Adsorption

Three types of adsorbers are usually found in industrial applications: (1) fixed beds, (2) moving beds, and (3) fluidized beds (Figure 36).

Fixed beds of regenerable or disposable media are most common. Carbon filter elements are a typical example.

Moving beds use granular adsorbers placed on inclined trays or on vertical frames similar to those used in granular bed particulate collectors. Moving beds offer continuous contaminant control and regeneration. Often, moving bed adsorbers and regeneration equipment are integrated components in a process.

Fluidized beds contain a fine granular adsorber, which is continuously mixed with the contaminated gas by suspension in the process gas stream. The bed may be either "fixed" at lower superficial velocities or highly turbulent and conveying (circulating). Illustrations of these types of fluidized beds are shown in Figure 36.

Solvent Recovery

The most common use of adsorption in stationary sources is in recovering solvent vapors from manufacturing and cleaning processes. Typical applications include solvent degreasing, rotogravure printing, dry cleaning, and the manufacture of such products as synthetic fibers, adhesive labels, tapes, coated copying paper, rubber goods, and coated fabrics.

Figure 37 illustrates the components of a typical solvent recovery system using two carbon beds. One bed is used as an adsorber while the other is regenerated with low-pressure steam. Desorbed solvent vapor and steam are recovered in a water-cooled condenser. If the solvent is immiscible with water, an automatic decanter separates the solvent for reuse. A distillation column is used for water-miscible solvents.

Adsorption time per cycle typically runs from 30 min to several hours. The adsorbing carbon bed is switched to regeneration by (1) an automatic timer shortly before the solvent vapor breaks through from the bed or (2) an organic vapor-sensing control device in the exhaust gas stream immediately after the solvent breaks through from the bed.

Low-pressure steam consumption for regeneration is generally about 2.2 kW per kilogram of solvent recovered (Boll 1976), but it

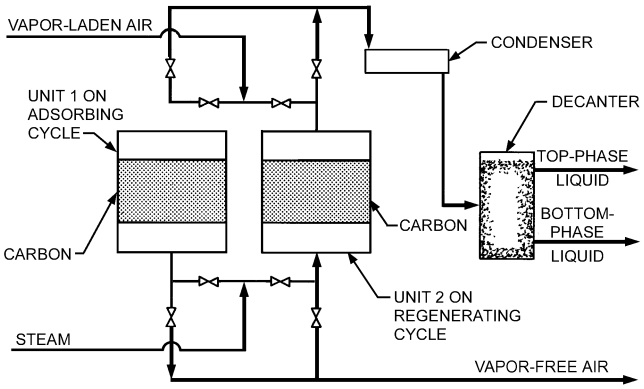


Fig. 37 Schematic of Two-Unit Fixed Bed Adsorber

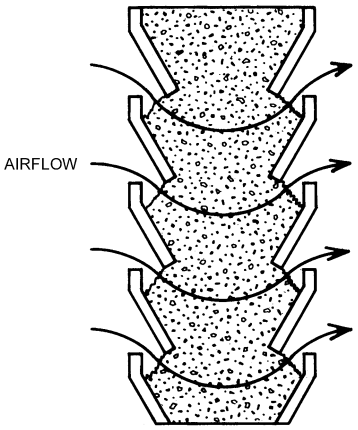


Fig. 38 Moving-Bed Adsorber

can range from 1.3 to over 3 kW per kilogram of solvent recovered, depending on the specific solvent and its concentration in the exhaust gas stream being stripped. Steam with only a slight superheat is normally used, so that it condenses quickly and gives rapid heat transfer.

After steaming, the hot, moist carbon bed is usually cooled and partially dried before being placed back on stream. Heat for drying is supplied by the cooling of the carbon and adsorber, and sometimes by an external air heater. In most cases, it is desirable to leave some moisture in the bed. When solvent vapors are adsorbed, heat is generated. For most common solvents, the heat of adsorption is 90 to 140 J/mol. When high-concentration vapors are adsorbed in a dry carbon bed, this heat can cause a substantial temperature rise and can even ignite the bed, unless it is controlled. If the bed contains moisture, the water absorbs energy and helps to prevent an undue rise in bed temperature. Certain applications may require heat sensors and automatic sprinklers.

Because the adsorptive capacity of activated carbon depends on temperature, it is important that solvent-laden air going to a recovery unit be as cool as is practicable. The exhaust gases from many solvent-emitting processes (such as drying ovens) are at elevated temperatures. Water- or air-cooled heat exchangers must be installed to reduce the temperature of the gas that enters the adsorber.

Solvent at very low vapor concentrations can be recovered in an activated carbon system. The size and cost of the recovery unit, however, depend on the volume of air to be handled; it is thus advantageous to minimize the volume of an exhaust stream and keep the solvent vapor concentration as high as possible, consistent with safety requirements. Insurance carriers specify that solvent vapor concentrations must not exceed 25% of the lower explosive limit (LEL) when intermittent monitoring is used. With continuous monitoring, concentrations as high as 50% of the LEL are permissible.

Solvent recovery systems, with gas-handling capacities up to about 5 m^3/s, are available as skid-mounted packages. Several of these packaged units can be used for larger gas flows. Custom systems can be built to handle 100 m^3/s or more of gas. Materials of construction may be painted carbon steel, stainless steel, Monel, or even titanium, depending on the nature of the gas mixture. The activated carbon is usually placed in horizontal flat beds or vertical cylindrical beds. The latter design minimizes ground space required for the system. Other alternatives are possible; one manufacturer uses a segmented horizontal rotating cylinder of carbon in which one segment is adsorbing while others are being steamed and cooled.

Commercial-scale solvent recovery systems typically recover over 99% of the solvent contained in a gas stream. The efficiency of the collecting hoods at the source of the solvent emission is usually the determining factor in solvent recovery.

Dust filters are generally placed ahead of carbon beds to prevent blinding of the adsorber by dust. Occasionally, the carbon is removed for screening to eliminate accumulated dust and fine particles of carbon.

If the solvent mixture contains high-boiling-point components, the working capacity of activated carbon can decrease with time. This occurs when high-boiling-point organic compounds are only partially removed by low-pressure steam. In this situation, two alternatives should be considered:

1. Periodic removal of the carbon and return to its manufacturer for high-temperature furnace reactivation to virgin carbon activity.
2. Use of more rigorous solvent desorbing conditions in the solvent recovery system. High-temperature steam, hot inert gas, or a combination of electrical heating and application of a vacuum may be used. The last method is selected, for example, to recover lithography ink solvents with high boiling points. Note that this method may not remove all of the high-boiling-point compounds.

Odor Control

Incineration and scrubbing are usually the most economical methods of controlling high concentrations of odorous compounds from equipment such as cookers in rendering plants. However, many odors that arise from harmlessly low concentrations of vapors are still offensive. The odor threshold (for 100% response) of acrolein in air, for example, is only 0.21 ppm, whereas that for ethyl mercaptan is 0.001 ppm and that for hydrogen sulfide is 0.0005 ppm (AIHA 1989; MCA 1968). Activated carbon beds effectively overcome many odor emission problems. Activated carbon is used to control odors from chemical and pharmaceutical manufacturing operations, foundries, sewage treating plants, oil and chemical storage tanks, lacquer drying ovens, food processing plants, and rendering plants. In some of these applications, activated carbon is the sole odor control method; in others, the carbon adsorber is applied to the exhaust from a scrubber.

Odor control systems using activated carbon can be as simple as a steel drum fitted with appropriate gas inlet and outlet ducts, or as complex as a large, vertically moving bed, in which carbon is contained between louvered side panels. A typical moving-bed adsorber is shown in Figure 38. In this arrangement, fresh carbon can be added at the top, and spent or dust-laden carbon is periodically removed from the bottom.

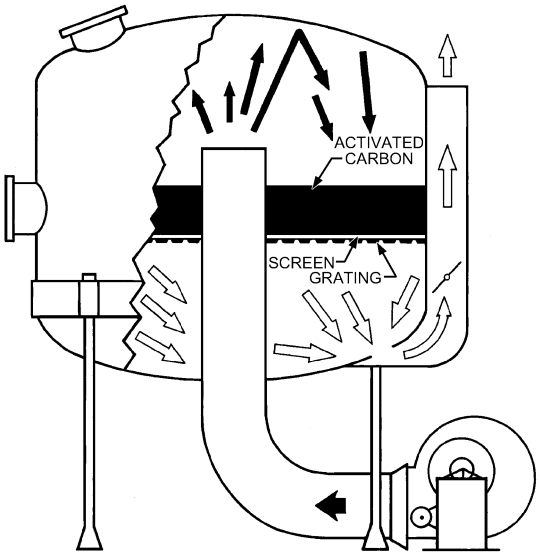


Fig. 39 Typical Odor Adsorber

Figure 39 shows a fixed-bed odor adsorber. Adsorbers of this general configuration are available as packaged systems, complete with motor and blower. Air-handling capacities range from 0.2 to 6 m^3/s.

The life of activated carbon in odor control systems ranges from a few weeks to a year or more, depending on the concentration of the odorous emission.

Applications of Fluidized Bed Adsorbers

The injection of alkali compounds into fluidized bed combustors for control of sulfur-containing compounds is one example of the use of fluidized bed adsorbers. Another example is the control of HF emissions from Søderberg aluminum reduction processes by a fixed or circulating fluidized bed of alumina.

3.4 INCINERATION OF GASES AND VAPORS

Incineration is the process by which volatile organic compounds (VOCs), organic aerosols, and most odorous materials in a contaminated gas stream are converted to innocuous carbon dioxide and water vapor using heat energy. Incineration is an effective means for totally eliminating VOCs. The types of incineration commonly used for air pollution control are thermal and catalytic, sometimes with recuperative or regenerative heat recovery.

To differentiate such air-cleaning systems from liquid and solid waste incinerators, the preferred term to describe such gas and aerosol phase air pollution control systems is now **oxidizers**.

Thermal Oxidizers

Thermal oxidizers, also known as **afterburners** or **direct flame incinerators**, consist of an insulated oxidation chamber in which gas and/or oil burners are typically located. The contaminated gas stream enters the chamber and comes into direct contact with the flame, which provides the heat energy necessary to promote oxidation. Under the proper conditions of time, temperature, and turbulence, the gas stream contaminants are oxidized effectively. The contaminated gas stream enters the combustion chamber near the burner, where turbulence-inducing devices are usually installed. The final contaminant conversion efficiency largely depends on good mixing in the contaminated gas stream and on the temperature of the oxidation chamber.

Supplemental fuel is used for start-up, to raise the temperature of the contaminated gas stream enough to initiate contaminant oxidation. Once oxidation begins, the temperature rises further because of the energy released by combustion of the contaminant. The supplementary fuel feed rate is then modulated to maintain the desired oxidizer operating temperature. Most organic gases oxidize to approximately 90% conversion efficiency if a temperature of at least 650°C and a residence time of 0.3 to 0.5 s are achieved in the oxidation chamber. However, oxidation temperatures are typically maintained in the range of 760 to 820°C with residence times of 0.5 to 1 s to ensure conversion efficiencies of 95% or greater.

Although the efficiency of thermal oxidizers can exceed 95% destruction of the contaminant, the reaction may form undesirable products of combustion. For example, oxidation of chlorinated hydrocarbons causes the formation of hydrogen chloride, which can have an adverse effect on equipment. These new contaminants then require additional controls.

Oxidation systems incorporate primary heat recovery to preheat the incoming contaminated gas stream and, in some cases, provide secondary heat recovery for process or building heating. Primary heat recovery is almost always achieved using air-to-air heat exchangers. Use of a regenerable, ceramic medium for heat recovery has increased due to superior heat recovery efficiency. Secondary heat recovery may incorporate an air-to-air heat exchanger or a waste heat boiler (DOE 1979).

Oxidation systems using conventional air-to-air heat exchangers can achieve up to 80% heat recovery efficiency. Regenerative heat exchanger units have claimed as high as 95% heat recovery efficiency and are routinely operated at 85 to 90%. When operated at these high heat recovery efficiencies and with inlet VOC concentrations of 15 to 25% of the LEL, the oxidation process approaches a self-sustaining condition, requiring very little supplementary fuel.

Catalytic Oxidizers

Catalytic oxidizers operate under the same principles as thermal oxidizers, except that they use a catalyst to promote oxidation. The catalyst allows oxidation to occur at lower temperatures than in a thermal oxidizer for the same VOC concentration. Therefore, catalytic oxidizers require less supplemental fuel to preheat the contaminated gas stream and have lower overall operating temperatures.

A catalytic oxidizer generally consists of a preheat chamber followed by the catalyst bed. Residence time and turbulence are not as important as with thermal oxidizers, but it is essential that the contaminated gas stream be heated uniformly to the required catalytic reaction temperature. The required temperature varies, depending on the catalyst material and configuration.

The temperature of the contaminated gas stream is raised in the preheat chamber by a conventional burner. Although the contaminated gas stream contacts the burner flame, the heat input is significantly less than that for a thermal oxidizer, and only a small degree of direct contaminant oxidation occurs. Natural gas is preferred to prevent catalyst contamination, which could occur with sulfur-bearing fuel oils. However, No. 2 fuel oil units have been operated successfully. The most effective catalysts contain noble metals such as platinum or palladium.

Catalysis occurs at the molecular level. Therefore, an available, active catalyst surface area is important for maintaining high conversion efficiencies. If particulate materials contact the catalyst as either discrete or partially oxidized aerosols, they can ash on the catalyst surface and blind it. This problem is usually accompanied by a secondary pollution problem: odorous emissions caused by the partially oxidized organic compounds.

The greatest concern to users of catalytic oxidizers is **catalyst poisoning or deactivation**. Poisoning is caused by specific gas stream contaminants that chemically combine or alloy with the

active catalyst material. Poisons frequently cited include phosphorus, bismuth, arsenic, antimony, lead, tin, and zinc. The first five materials are considered fast-acting poisons and must be excluded from the contaminated gas stream. Even trace quantities of the fast-acting poisons can cause rapid catalyst deactivation. The last two materials are slow-acting poisons; catalysts are somewhat tolerant of these materials, particularly at temperatures lower than 540°C. However, even the slow poisons should be excluded from the contaminated gas stream to ensure continuous, reliable performance. Therefore, galvanized steel, another possible source of the slow poisons, should not be used for the duct leading to the oxidizer.

Sulfur and halogens are also regarded as catalyst poisons. In most cases, their chemical interaction with the active catalyst material is reversible. That is, catalyst activity can be restored by operating the catalyst without the halogen or sulfur-bearing compound in the gas stream. The potential problem of greater concern with respect to the halogen-bearing compounds is the formation of hydrogen chloride or hydrogen fluoride gas, or hydrochloric or hydrofluoric acid emissions.

Some organic compounds, such as polyester amides and imides, are also poisonous.

Catalytic oxidizers generally cost less to operate than thermal oxidizers because of their lower fuel consumption. With the exception of regenerative heat recovery techniques, primary and secondary heat recovery can be incorporated into a catalytic oxidation system to further reduce operating costs. Maintenance costs are usually higher for catalytic units, particularly if frequent catalyst cleaning or replacement is necessary. Concern over catalyst life has been the major factor limiting more widespread application of catalytic oxidizers.

Applications of Oxidizers

Odor Control. All highly odorous pollutant gases are combustible or chemically changed to less odorous pollutants when they are sufficiently heated. Often, the concentration of odorous materials in the waste gas is extremely low, and the only feasible method of control is oxidation. Odors from rendering plants, mercaptans, and organic sulfides from kraft pulping operations are examples of effluents that can be controlled by incineration. Other forms of oxidation can achieve the same ends (see Chapter 47 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*).

Reduction in Emissions of Reactive Hydrocarbons. Some air pollution control agencies regulate the emission of organic gases and vapors because of their involvement in photochemical smog reactions. Flame afterburning is an effective way of destroying these materials.

Reduction in Explosion Hazard. Refineries and chemical plants are among the factories that must dispose of highly combustible or otherwise dangerous organic materials. The safest method of disposal is usually by burning in flares or in specially designed furnaces. However, special precautions and equipment design must be used in the handling of potentially explosive mixtures.

Adsorption and Oxidation

Alternate cycles of adsorption and desorption in an activated carbon bed are used to concentrate solvent or odor vapors before oxidation. This technique greatly reduces the fuel required for burning organic vapor emissions. Fuel savings of 98% compared to direct oxidation are possible. The process is particularly useful in cases where emission levels vary from hour to hour. This technique is common in metal finishing for automotive and office furniture manufacturing.

Contaminated gas is passed through a carbon bed until saturation occurs. The gas stream is then switched to another carbon bed, and the exhausted bed is shut down for desorption. A hot inert gas, usually burner flue gas, is introduced to the adsorber to drive off concentrated organic vapors and to convey them to an oxidizer. The volume of this desorbing gas stream is much smaller than the original contaminated gas volume, so that only a small oxidizer, operating intermittently, is required (Grandjacques 1977).

4. AUXILIARY EQUIPMENT

4.1 DUCTS

Basic duct design is covered in Chapter 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. This chapter covers only those duct components or problems that warrant special concern when handling gases that contain particulate or gaseous contaminants.

Duct systems should be designed to allow thermal expansion or contraction as gases move from the process, through gas-cleaning equipment, and on to the ambient environment. Appropriately designed duct expansion joints must be located in proper relation to sliding and fixed duct supports. Besides withstanding maximum possible temperature, duct must also withstand maximum positive or negative pressure, a partial load of accumulated dust, and reasonable amounts of corrosion. Duct supports should be designed to accommodate these overload conditions as well. Bottom entries into duct junctions create a low-velocity area that can allow contaminants to settle out, thus creating a potential fire hazard. Bottom duct entries should be avoided.

Where gases might condense and cause corrosion or sticky deposits, duct should be insulated or fabricated from materials that will survive this environment. A psychrometric analysis of the exhaust gases is useful to determine the dew point. Surface temperatures should then be held above the dew-point temperature by preheating on start-up or by insulating. Slag traps with clean-out doors, inspection doors where direction changes, and dead-end full-sized caps are required for systems having heavy particulate loading. Special attention should be given to high-temperature duct, where the duct might corrode if insulated or become encrusted when molten particulate impacts on cool, uninsulated surfaces. Water-cooled duct or refractory lining is often used where the high operating temperature exceeds the safe limits of low-cost materials.

Gas flow through ducts should be considered as a part of overall system design. Good gas flow distribution is essential for measurements of process conditions and can lead to energy savings and increased system life. The minimum speed of gases in a duct should be sufficiently high to convey the heaviest particulate fraction with a degree of safety.

Slide gates, balance gates, equipment bypass ducts, and clean-out doors should be incorporated in the duct system to allow for maintenance of key gas-cleaning systems. In some cases, emergency bypass circuitry should be included to vent emissions and protect gas-cleaning equipment from process upsets.

Temperature Controls

Control of gas temperature in a gas-cleaning system is often vital to a system's performance and life. In some cases, gases are cooled to concentrate contaminants, condense gases, and recover energy. In other cases, gas-cleaning equipment, such as fabric filters and scrubbers, can only operate at well-controlled temperatures. Cooling exhaust gases through air-to-air heat transfer has been highly successful in many applications. Controlled evaporative cooling is also used, but it increases the dew point and the danger of acid gas condensation and/or the formation of sticky deposits. However, controlled evaporative cooling to within 28 K of dew point has been used with success. Dilution by injecting ambient air into the duct is expensive because it increases the volumetric flow of gas and, consequently, the size of collector needed to meet gas-cleaning objectives. Water-cooled duct is often used where the gas temperature exceeds the safe limits of the low-cost materials.

For dilution cooling, louver-type dampers are often used to inject ambient air and provide fine temperature control. Controls can be used to provide full modulation of the damper or to provide open or closed operation. Emergency bypass damper systems and bypass duct/stacks are used where limiting excessive temperature is critical.

Fans

Because static pressure across a gas-cleaning device varies depending on conditions, the fan should operate on the steep portion of the fan pressure-volumetric flow curve. This tends to provide less variation in the volumetric flow. An undersized fan has a steeper characteristic than an oversized fan for the same duty; however, it will be noisier.

In the preferred arrangement, the fan is located on the clean gas side of gas-cleaning equipment. Advantages of placing the fan at this point include the following:

- A fan on the clean gas side handles clean gases and minimizes abrasive exposure from the collected product.
- High-efficiency backward-blade and airfoil designs can be selected because accumulation on the fan wheel is not as great a factor.
- Escape of hazardous materials through leaks is minimized.
- The collector can be installed inside the plant, even near the process, because any leakage in the duct or collector will be into the system and will not increase the potential for exposure. However, the fan itself should be mounted outdoors, so that the positive-pressure duct is outside the work environment.

For economic reasons, a fan may be located on the contaminant-laden side of the gas-cleaning equipment if the contaminants are relatively nonabrasive, and especially if the equipment can be located outdoors. This arrangement should be avoided because of the potential for leakage of concentrated contaminants to the environment. In some instances, however, the collector housing design, duct design, and energy savings of this arrangement reduce costs.

Most scrubbers are operated on the suction side of the fan. This not only eliminates leakage of contaminants into the work area, but also allows for servicing the unit while it is in operation. Additionally, such an arrangement minimizes corrosion of the fan. Stacks on the exhaust streams of scrubbers should be arranged to drain condensate rather than allow it to accumulate and reenter the fan.

Fabric filters require special consideration. When new, clean fabric is installed in a collector, the resistance is low, and the fan motor may be overloaded. This overloading may be prevented during start-up by using a temporary throttling damper in the main duct, for example, on the clean side of the filter in a pull-through system. Overloading may also be prevented by using a backward-curved blade (nonoverloading fan) on the clean side of the collector.

4.2 DUST- AND SLURRY-HANDLING EQUIPMENT

Once the particulate matter is collected, new control problems arise from the need to remove, transport, and dispose of material from the collector. A study of all potential methods for handling the collected material, which might be a hazardous waste, must be an integral part of initial system design.

Hoppers

Dust collector hoppers are intended only to channel collected material to the hopper's outlet, where it is continuously discharged. When hoppers are used to store dust, the plates and charging electrodes of electrostatic precipitators can be shorted electrically, resulting in failure of entire electrical sections. Fabric collectors, particularly those that have the gas inlet in the hopper, are usually designed on the assumption that the hopper is not used for storage and that collected waste is continuously removed. High dust levels in the hoppers of fabric collectors often result in high dust reentrainment. This reentrainment causes increased operating pressure and the potential for fabric damage. Excessive dust levels not only expose the system to potentially corrosive conditions and fire/explosion hazards, but also place increased structural demands on the system.

Aside from misuse of hoppers for storage, common problems with dust-handling equipment include (1) plugging of hoppers, (2) blockage of dust valves with solid objects, and (3) improper or insufficient maintenance.

Hopper auxiliaries to be considered include (1) insulation, (2) dust level indicators, (3) rapper plates, (4) vibrators, (5) heaters, and (6) "poke" holes.

Hopper Discharge. Dust is often removed continuously from hoppers by means of rotary valves. Alternative equipment includes the double-flap valve, or vacuum system valves. Wet electrostatic precipitators and scrubbers often use sluice valves and drains to ensure that insoluble particulate remains in suspension during discharge.

Dust Conveyors

Larger dust collectors are fitted with one or more conveyors to feed dust to a central discharge location or to return it to a process. Drag, screw, and pneumatic conveyors are commonly used with dust collectors. Sequential start-up of conveyor systems is essential. Motion switches to monitor operation of the conveyor are useful.

Dust Disposal

Several methods are available for disposal of collected dust. It can be emptied into dumpsters in its as-collected dry form or be pelletized and hauled to a landfill. It can also be converted to a slurry and pumped to a settling pond or to clarification equipment. The advantages and disadvantages of each method are beyond the scope of this chapter, but they should be evaluated for each application.

Slurry Treatment

When slurry from wet collectors cannot be returned directly to the process or tailing pond, liquid clarification and treatment systems can be used for recycling the water to prevent stream pollution. Stringent stream pollution regulations make even a small discharge of bleed water a problem. Clarification equipment may include settling tanks, sludge-handling facilities, and, possibly, centrifuges or vacuum filters. Provisions must be provided for handling and disposal of dewatered sludge, so that secondary pollution problems do not develop.

5. OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE

A planned program for operation and maintenance of equipment is a necessity. Such programs are becoming mandatory because of the need for operators to prove continuous compliance with emission and safety regulations. Good housekeeping and record-keeping will also help prolong the life of the equipment, support a program for positive relations with regulatory and community groups, and aid problem-solving efforts, should nonroutine maintenance or service be necessary.

A typical program includes the following minimum requirements (Stern et al. 1984):

- Central location for filing equipment records, warranties, instruction manuals, etc.
- Lubrication and cleaning schedules
- Planning and scheduling of preventive maintenance (including inspection and major repair)
- Storeroom and inventory system for spare parts and supplies
- Listing of maintenance personnel (including supplier contacts and consultants)

- Costs and budgets for activities associated with operation and maintenance of the equipment
- Storage for special tools and equipment

Industry standards have implemented safety requirements. A typical program includes the following minimum requirements (Stern et al. 1984):

- Using a central location for filing equipment records, warranties, instruction manuals, etc.
- Following lubrication and cleaning schedules
- Planning, scheduling, and performing preventive maintenance (including inspection and major repair)
- Maintaining a storeroom and inventory system for spare parts and supplies

For air pollution control and gas cleaning, the following items are more commonly needed to ensure the system is performing properly. These tasks are performed anywhere from daily to annually, depending on local needs, and can vary depending on the type of system installed:

- Inspections for leaks, moisture, dust accumulation, and abrasion
- System performance checks (operating performance points, discharges, inlets, outlets, system pressures, cleaning systems, airflows, etc.)
- Corrosion and electrical component checks

Corrosion

Because high-temperature gas cleaning often involves corrosive materials, chemical attack on system components must be anticipated. This is especially true if the temperature in a gas-cleaning system falls below the moisture or acid dew point. Housing insulation should be such that the internal metal surface temperature is 11 to 17 K greater than the moisture and/or acid dew point at all times. In applications with fabric filters where alkali materials are injected into the gas stream to react with acid gases, care must be taken to protect the clean side of the housing downstream of the fabric from corrosion.

Fires and Explosions

Air pollution control and industrial gas-cleaning systems often concentrate combustible materials and expose them to environments that are hostile and difficult to control. These environments also make fires difficult to detect and stop. These systems are, therefore, potential fire or explosion hazards (Billings and Wilder 1970; EEI 1980; Frank 1981).

Fires and explosions in industrial process exhaust streams are not generally limited to gas-cleaning equipment. Ignition may take place in the process itself, in the duct, or in exhaust system components other than the gas-cleaning equipment. Once uncontrolled combustion begins, it may propagate throughout the system.

The National Fire Protection Agency (NFPA) maintains the minimum standards for fire and other hazard prevention. The following are the main guidelines applicable to air pollution control and industrial gas cleaning, but it is possible more standards and codes are applicable, depending on the process. NFPA 68 and 69 are standards and guides to system protection; the others address fundamentals and industry specific combustible dust handling and hazard identification. Hazard identification is a requirement per NFPA 652, noting that any facility handling combustible dust perform a dust hazard analysis (DHA), which is a formalized process for identifying and evaluating the fire, deflagration, and explosion hazards associated with the dust and process, as well as providing recommendations on how to manage these.

NFPA 68, Standard on explosion protection by deflagration venting. Focuses on explosion venting on devises and systems that vent combustion gases and pressures resulting from a deflagration within an enclosure in order to minimize structural and mechanical damage.

NFPA 69, Standard on explosion prevention systems. Covers explosion protection of systems when venting is not possible. It incudes several prevention methods such as explosion suppression, deflagration pressure containment, and spark extinguishing systems.

NFPA 660 (Upcoming). Scheduled for release in autumn 2025, this new standard combines previous codes providing both fundamental and industry-specific standards for managing combustible dust, to promote best practices to safeguard facilities from related fires and dust explosions. These previous standards include

- 652, Standard on the fundamentals of combustible dust
- 654, Standard for the prevention of fire and dust explosions from the manufacturing, processing, and handling of combustible particulate solids
- 61, Standard for the prevention of fires and dust explosions in agricultural and food processing facilities
- 484, Standard for combustible metals
- 664, Standard for the prevention of fires and explosions in wood processing and woodworking facilities
- 655, Standard for the prevention of sulfur fires and explosions

NFPA Recommended Practices

- 77. Offers guidance on identifying, evaluating and controlling static electric hazards
- 499. For the classification of combustible dusts and hazardous (classified) locations for electrical installations in chemical process areas

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CHAPTER 31

AUTOMATIC FUEL-BURNING SYSTEMS

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FUEL-BURNING systems provide a means to mix fuel and air in the proper ratio, ignite it, control the position of the flame envelope within the combustion chamber, and control a fuel flow rate for safe combustion-heat energy release for space conditioning, water heating, and other processes. This chapter covers the design and use of automatic fuel-burning systems. The fuel can be gaseous (e.g., natural or liquefied petroleum gas), liquid (primarily the lighter grades of fuel oil or biodiesel), or solid (e.g., coal, or renewable items such as wood or corn). For discussion of some of these fuels, their combustion chemistry, and thermodynamics, see Chapter 28 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

1. GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

1.1 TERMINOLOGY

The following terminology for combustion systems, equipment, and fuel-fired appliances is consistent with usage in gas-fired appliance standards of the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) and Canadian Standards Association, the National Fire Protection Association's *National Fuel Gas Code* (ANSI *Standard* Z223.1/NFPA *Standard* 54), and the Canadian Standards Association's *Natural Gas and Propane Installation Code* (CSA *Standard* B149.1).

Air, circulating. Air distributed to habitable spaces for heating, cooling, or ventilation.

Air, dilution. Air that enters a draft hood or draft regulator and mixes with flue gas.

Air, excess. Air that passes through the combustion chamber in excess of the amount required for complete (stoichiometric) combustion.

Air, primary. Air introduced into a burner that mixes with fuel gas before the mixture reaches the burner ports.

Air, secondary. Air supplied to the combustion zone downstream of the burner ports.

Appliance. Any device that uses a gas, a liquid, or a solid as a fuel or raw material to produce light, heat, power, refrigeration, or air conditioning.

Draft. Negative static pressure, measured relative to atmospheric pressure; thus, positive draft is negative static pressure. Draft is the force (buoyancy of hot flue gas or other form of energy) that produces flow and causes pressure drop through an appliance combustion system and/or vent system. See Chapter 34 for additional information.

Equipment. Devices other than appliances, such as supply piping, service regulators, sediment traps, and vents in buildings.

Flue. General term for passages and conduit through which flue gases pass from the combustion chamber to the outdoors.

Flue gas. Products of combustion plus excess air in appliance flues, heat exchangers, and vents.

Input rate. Fuel-burning capacity of an appliance in kilowatts as specified by the manufacturer. Appliance input ratings are marked on appliance rating plates.

Vent. Passageway used to convey flue gases from appliances or their vent connectors to the outdoors.

Vent gas. Products of combustion plus excess air and dilution air in vents.

1.2 SYSTEM APPLICATION

The following considerations are important in the design, specification, and/or application of systems for combustion of fossil fuels.

Safety. Safety is of prime concern in the design and operation of automatic fuel-burning appliances. For more information, see the sections on Safety and Controls. Appliance standards and installation codes (e.g., ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA *Standard* 2.3 for gas-fired central furnaces and ANSI Z223.1/NFPA 54, *National Fuel Gas Code*, in the United States) provide minimum safety requirements. Appliance manufacturers may include additional safety components to address hazards not covered by appliance standards and installation codes.

Suitability for Application. The system must meet the requirements of the application, not only in heating capacity, but also in its ability to handle the load profile. It must be suitable for its environment and for the substance to be heated.

Combustion System Type. System operation is very much a function of the type of burner(s), means for moving combustion products through the system, proper combustion air supply, and venting of combustion gases to the outdoors.

Efficiency. Efficiency can be specified in various ways, depending on the application. Stack loss and heat output are common measures, but for some applications, transient operation must be considered. In very high-efficiency appliances, heat extraction from combustion products may cool vent gas below its dew point, so condensation of water vapor in the combustion products must be handled, and venting design must consider corrosion by combustion products, as well as their lack of buoyancy.

Operating Control. Heat load or process requirements may occur in batches or may be transient events. The burner control system must accommodate those requirements, and the combustion system must be able to respond to the controls.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.10, Fuels and Combustion.

Emissions. For safety and air quality reasons, combustion products must not contain excessive levels of noxious materials, notably carbon monoxide, oxides of nitrogen, unburned hydrocarbons, and particulate material such as soot.

Fuel Provision. Liquid and solid fuels, liquefied gases, and some gaseous fuels require space for storage. Gaseous and liquid fuels require appropriate piping for the fuel-burning system. Fuel storage and delivery provisions must be of adequate capacity and must be designed to ensure safe operation.

Sustainability. Fuel-burning appliances consume fuel resources and produce combustion products that are emitted to the atmosphere. The effect of these inherent characteristics can be minimized by using highly efficient systems with very low emissions of undesirable substances. (See the section on Efficiency and Emission Ratings.) Appliances using environmentally neutral (nonfossil) fuel, such as biofuels processed from vegetable oils and biomass material (e.g., forestry waste), are available. New technologies are also emerging. Through photosynthesis, biomass chlorophyll captures energy from the sun by converting carbon dioxide from the atmosphere and water from the ground into carbohydrates, complex compounds composed of carbon, hydrogen, and oxygen. When these carbohydrates are burned, they are converted back into carbon dioxide and water, and release the sun's energy. In this way, biomass stores solar energy and is renewable and carbon neutral (UCS 2007).

Venting, Combustion Air Supply, and Appliance Installation. Combustion product gases must be handled properly to ensure safety and satisfactory system operation. Adequate air supply must be provided for combustion and ventilation. Appliances must be located to provide safe clearance from combustible material and for convenient service.

Standards and Codes. Building codes typically require that fuel-burning appliances be design-certified or listed to comply with nationally recognized standards. Appliance construction, safe operation, installation practices, and emissions requirements are often specified. In some locations, codes require special restraint for seismic or high wind conditions.

Cost. The choice of fuel-burning system is often based on it being the least expensive way to provide the heat needed for a process. The basic cost of energy tends to narrow the choices, but the total cost of purchase and ownership should dictate the final decision. Initial cost is the cost of the appliance(s), associated equipment and controls, and installation labor. Operating cost includes the cost of fuel, other utilities, maintenance, depreciation, and various ongoing charges, taxes, fees, etc. Energy cost analysis may indicate that one fuel is best for some loads and seasons, and another fuel is best for other times. Substantial operating cost is incurred if skilled personnel are required for operation and maintenance. Sometimes these costs can be reduced by appliances and control systems that automate operation and allow remote monitoring of system performance and maintenance requirements. Warranties should be considered. See Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for a thorough discussion of costs.

1.3 SAFETY

All appliance systems must either operate safely or have a way to sense unsafe operation, and safely and promptly shut off the fuel supply before injury or property damage occurs. Safe and unsafe operation sensing and control is generally designed into the combustion control system. Examples of what controls must detect, evaluate, and act on include the following:

- Time to achieve fuel ignition
- Sufficient combustion air and/or flue gas flow rates
- Fuel flow rate (e.g., gas orifice pressure)
- Loss of flame
- Heat exchange operation (e.g., circulating air blower operating speed and timing for furnaces)
- Flame containment (flame rollout)
- Appliance component temperatures
- Loss of control power supply

1.4 EFFICIENCY AND EMISSION RATINGS

Heating capacity may be the primary factor in selecting fuel-burning appliances, but efficiency and emission ratings are often of equal importance to building owners and governmental regulators.

Steady-State and Cyclic Efficiency

Efficiency calculations are discussed in Chapter 28 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Boiler and furnace efficiencies are discussed in Chapters 32 and 33 of this volume.

Stack Efficiency. Stack efficiency is a widely used rating approach based on measurement of the temperature and composition of gases exhausted by fuel-burning appliances. Knowing the oxygen or carbon dioxide concentration of the flue gases and the fuel's hydrocarbon content provides a measure of stack mass flow. In conjunction with flue gas temperature, these data allow determination of energy loss in the flue gas exiting the stack. The difference between stack loss and energy input is assumed to be useful energy, and stack efficiency is the ratio of that useful energy to energy input, expressed as a percentage. Generally, the rating is applied to steady-state combustion processes. Flue gas carbon dioxide and oxygen concentrations are affected mostly by the fuel's hydrocarbon content and by the appliance's combustion system design. Flue gas temperature is mostly affected by the appliance's heat exchanger design.

Heat Output Efficiency. Some rating standards require actual measurement of heat transferred to the substance being heated. Heat output measurement accounts for all heat losses, not just those in the flue gases. Nonstack heat loss, often called **jacket loss**, is difficult to measure and may be quite small, but can be accounted for by measuring heat output. The ratio of heat output to energy input, expressed as a percentage, is the heat output efficiency.

Load Profile Efficiency. U.S. Federal Trade Commission rules require that some types of residential appliances be rated under protocols that consider load profile. Residential and commercial space-heating furnaces and boilers, for example, are rated by their **annual fuel utilization efficiency (AFUE)**, which considers steady-state efficiency, heat-up and cooldown transients, and off-season energy consumption by gas pilot burners. Residential storage-type water heaters are rated under a protocol that requires measurement of energy consumption over a 24 h period, during which prescribed amounts of heated water are drawn. A water heater **energy factor** $\boldsymbol{E_f}$ is calculated from the measurements. The E_f rating accounts for standby losses (i.e., energy loss through the tank and fittings that does not go into the water). Ratings and discussion of AFUE and energy factors can be found in ASHRAE *Standard* 103 and in product directories by the Gas Appliance Manufacturers Association.

Emissions

Regulated Flue Gas Constituents. Appliance safety standards and environmental regulations specify limits for various substances that may be found in combustion flue gases. Substances most often regulated are carbon monoxide, oxides of nitrogen, and soot. Limits for sulfur oxides, unburned hydrocarbons, and other particulate matter may also be specified. Rules vary with location, type of installation, and type of combustion appliance. Regulations that restrict fuel sulfur content are generally intended to reduce sulfur oxide emissions, which may also reduce particulate emissions under certain conditions.

Flue Gas Concentration Limits. Standards and codes often specify maximum concentration levels permitted in flue gases.

Because flue gases may be diluted by air, requirements invariably specify that measured concentration levels be adjusted by calculation to a standard condition. In appliance certification standards, that condition is typically the air-free level (i.e., what the concentration would be if there were no excess air). Carbon monoxide, for example, is often limited to 400 parts per million air-free. Air quality regulations sometimes specify the maximum level for a fixed degree of excess air. For oxides of nitrogen, the level is often specified in parts per million at 3% oxygen. The calculation, in effect, adds or subtracts dilution air to reach a condition at which oxygen concentration is 3% of the exhaust gas volume.

Emission per Unit of Useful Heat. In some U.S. jurisdictions, regulations for gas-fired residential furnaces and water heaters require that emission of oxides of nitrogen not exceed a specified level in nanograms per joule of useful heat. Measured flue gas emission levels are compared with the benefit in terms of heat output. Under this rating method, high efficiency is rewarded. Regulations for new installations may differ from those for existing systems and may be more stringent.

Mass Released to Atmosphere. Emissions from large fuel-fired appliances are often regulated at the site in terms of mass released to the atmosphere. Limits may be expressed, for example, in terms of kilograms per gigajoule, or megagrams per year.

2. GAS-BURNING APPLIANCES

2.1 GAS-FIRED COMBUSTION SYSTEMS

Gas-burning combustion systems vary widely, the most significant differences being the type of burner and the means by which combustion products are moved through the system. Gas input rate control also has a substantial effect on combustion system design.

Burners

A primary function of a gas burner is mixing fuel gas and combustion air in the proper ratio before their arrival at the flame. In a **partially-aerated burner (Bunsen burner)**, only part of the necessary combustion air is mixed with the gas ahead of the flame. This primary air is typically about 30 to 50% of the stoichiometric air (i.e., that amount of air necessary for complete combustion of the gas). Combustion occurs at the point where adequate secondary air enters the combustion zone and diffuses into the mixture. In most cases, secondary air entry continues downstream of the burner and heat release is distributed accordingly. The total of primary and secondary air typically ranges from 140 to 180% of the stoichiometric air (i.e., 40 to 80% excess air).

Most often, partially aerated burners are **atmospheric** or **natural-draft burners** (i.e., they operate without power assist of any kind), which have the advantage of quiet operation. Fuel gas is injected from a pressurized gas supply through an injector (orifice) to form a gas jet, which propels discharged gas into the burner throat, entraining primary air by viscous shear. Primary air may also be drawn into the burner throat by venturi action. Fuel gas and air are mixed in a mixing tube before their arrival at the burner ports where burning occurs. A typical partially aerated burner is illustrated in Figure 1.

A **premix burner** is a power burner in which all or nearly all of the combustion air is mixed with the fuel gas before arrival at the flame. Because the necessary air is present at the flame front, combustion and heat release take place in a compact zone and there is no need for secondary aeration. Combustion quality (i.e., emission performance) tends to be better than that of partially aerated burners because of inherent mixing advantages, resulting in lower peak temperatures and lower residence times at these temperatures. This especially benefits NO_x emission levels. Premix burners can normally be operated at lower excess air levels (often 15 to 20%) to increase combustion efficiency. Low excess air increases flame temperature, which enhances heat exchange but imposes greater thermal stress on the combustion chamber and its components. Extremely low excess air may result in higher CO and/or NO_x emissions, as with any burner design.

A fan is almost always necessary to force the mixture of gas and air through a premix burner. Airflow is three or four times that through partially aerated burners, and the associated pressure drop is normally too much to be handled by fuel gas entrainment or stack draft. In general, appliances with premix burners are tuned more finely than those with partially aerated burners, to take advantage of their inherent advantages and to ensure reliable operation. A typical premix burner system is illustrated in Figure 2.

Combustion System Flow

In broad terms, flow through the combustion system (i.e., burner, combustion chamber, heat exchanger, and venting) is powered by natural draft and/or by a fan.

In a **natural-draft system**, the low density of hot combustion products creates a buoyant flow through the combustion chamber, heat exchanger, and venting system. The amount of flow through the system is a function of many factors, including chimney height, diameter, flue gas temperature, and friction loss through the appliance and vent system components. For additional information, see Chapter 35.

Fan-assisted combustion systems have become common. A fan pushes or pulls combustion air, flue gas products, and fuel gas through the burner, and combustion products through the combustion chamber and heat exchanger (and, in some cases, the venting). Some fan-assisted systems use atmospheric burners, applying the fan power mainly to force flow through an enhanced heat exchange process. Serpentine heat exchangers, for example, typically require fan assist because they have too much pressure drop to operate in natural-draft mode. In systems with significant burner pressure drop, such as that of a premix burner, fan power is required for the burner as well. Fan-assisted systems can operate with or without pressurizing the vent, depending on the flow rate of the combustion system, flue gas conditions (temperature and buoyancy), resistance of the venting system, and location of an induced-draft fan, if used. For more information, see the discussion of venting in the Applications section.

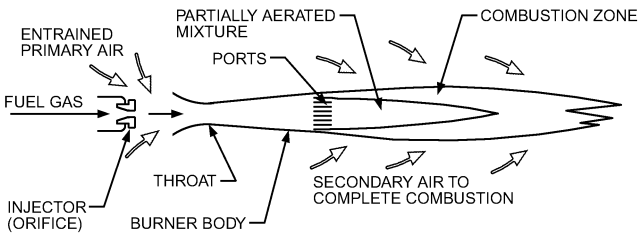


Fig. 1 Partially Aerated (Bunsen) Burner

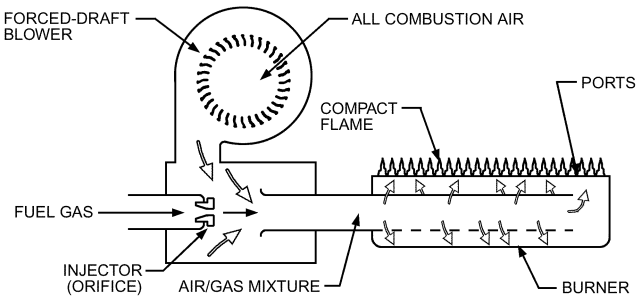


Fig. 2 Premix Burner

Forced-draft systems (Figure 3) use a fan to force air into the combustion chamber and heat exchanger under positive pressure (higher than atmospheric). Often, forced-draft systems also operate with positive pressure in at least part of the vent system.

Induced-draft systems (Figure 4) use a fan in the appliance near the flue collar or vent outlet to pull flue gas through the combustion chamber and heat exchanger. These systems operate with negative pressure at all points before the fan.

Packaged power burners are often used in factory-built heating appliances and in field-assembled installations. These burners include all gas- and air-handling components, along with ignition controls, housing, mechanical means for mounting to the heating appliance, and connection of fuel gas and electric power. They tend to have a gun-type configuration (i.e., gas and air are mixed in an outlet tube with burner head, the latter inserted into the heating appliance's combustion chamber). Packaged power burners may also include special hardware and controls for gas input rate control, and some may include special features to reduce combustion emissions. Flue gas recirculation (i.e., returning some combustion products to the flame) is sometimes used to reduce NO_x production. A typical packaged power burner is shown in Figure 5.

Pulse combustion is a process in which combustion system flow is motivated by low-frequency pressure pulses created in the combustion chamber by cyclic/repetitive self-generating ignition of an air/gas mixture. It provides low emission levels and enhanced heat transfer. The oscillating nature of flow through the system provides a beneficial "scrubbing" effect on heat exchanger surfaces. Additional discussion of pulse combustion is provided in Chapter 28 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals.*

Ignition

Safety standards and codes specify requirements for ignition and proof of flame presence. Good design practices result in ignition that is immediate, smooth, and complete. Once flame is established, the ongoing presence of the ignition source or the flame itself must be ensured (i.e., flame supervision by the combustion control must detect loss of pilot and/or main flame and immediately shut off fuel gas flow). **Pilot burners** have been used very effectively for decades in appliances such as small residential water heaters and in very large field-assembled installations. The pilot flame may be detected by a temperature sensor (thermocouple) or by various electronic sensing systems. Pilot flames may be continuous or ignited only when there is a demand for heat (**intermittent pilot** operation).

Some types of appliances use **direct ignition**. A **spark igniter** or a **hot surface igniter** is applied directly at the main burner ports to ignite the gas/air mixture. Direct-ignition systems also include a means, usually electronic, to sense presence of the flame.

Ignition system standards and installation codes usually include requirements for other parameters such as flame failure response time, trial for ignition, and combustion chamber purging. For listed or design-certified appliances, applicable requirements have been test-verified by listing or certifying agencies. Other appliances and those installed in some building occupancy classes may be subject to special ignition and flame safety requirements in building and safety codes or by insurance underwriters. (See the section on Controls for more detail.)

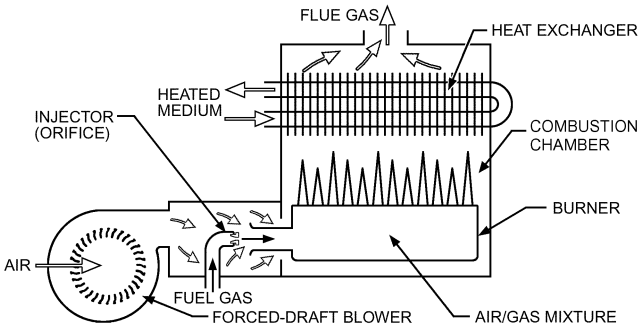


Fig. 3 Forced-Draft Combustion System

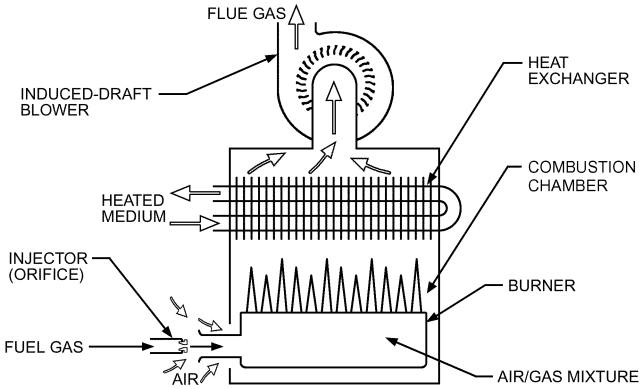


Fig. 4 Induced-Draft Combustion System

Input Rate Control

A wide range of heat input is sometimes required of gas-fired appliances. Space heating, for example, is often done by zones, and must work under a wide range of outdoor conditions. Some water-heating and process applications also require a wide gas input rate range, and transients can be very steep input rate swings. Gas burners with staged or modulating control can be applied to meet these requirements.

Staged systems can be operated at discrete input rate levels, from full rated input to preset lower rates, sometimes with airflow remaining at the full-rate level and sometimes with proportional control of combustion air. Efficiency can be enhanced when combustion air is proportionally controlled, because flame temperature can remain high while the amount of heat exchanger surface per unit of input effectively becomes larger. A common staging approach uses a two-stage gas pressure regulator to change fuel gas pressure at an injector or metering orifice(s). In other designs, staging is accomplished by operating groups of individual burners or combustion chambers, each under control of its own gas valve and, if necessary, having its own ignition control. An extension of this approach is to use multiple individual heating appliances, controlled such that one or more can be called on as needed to meet the demand.

Modulating burner systems vary the input rate continuously, from full rated input to a minimum value. Modulation may be done by a throttling device in the gas burner piping, or with a modulating gas pressure regulator. Modulating systems require special controllers to provide a signal to the gas flow control device that is in some

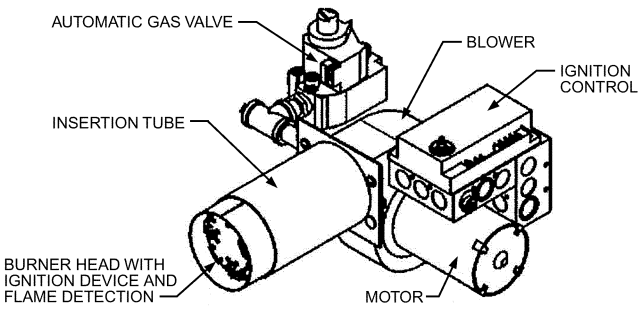


Fig. 5 Packaged Power Burner

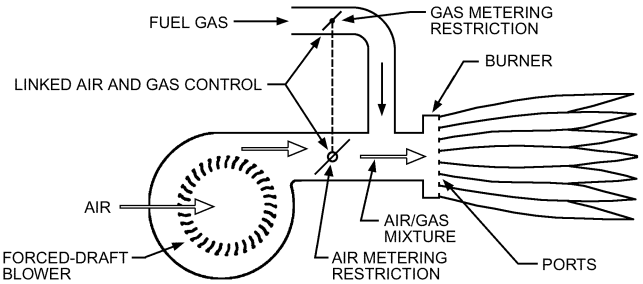


Fig. 6 Combustion System with Linked Air and Gas Flow

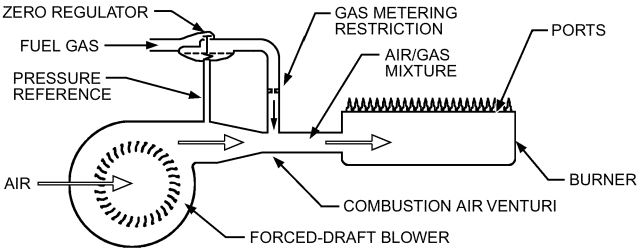


Fig. 7 Pneumatically Linked Gas/Air Ratio Combustion System

way proportional to the demand. As with staged systems, some designs provide commensurate control of combustion air, whereas others control only gas input rate with constant combustion airflow rate. Figure 6 illustrates a system in which combustion air and gas flow rates are throttled and linked.

Pneumatically linked gas/air ratio burner systems, in which combustion air is controlled and gas follows proportionately, are a type of modulating burner system. One such system is shown in Figure 7. In these systems, airflow is controlled by dampers or a variable-speed fan. Combustion air is directed through a restriction (typically a venturi), so that the pressure drop across this restriction increases as a function of air mass flow (in accordance with the Bernoulli Equation). A fuel gas regulator is referenced to the upstream side of this restriction and controls gas flow into the combustion air at a point downstream of the restriction. The regulator set point is fixed (often very close to zero). As airflow increases through the restriction, so does the pressure drop across it. As this happens, the regulator must open further, increasing the gas flow, to maintain its set point. At a regulator set point of zero, the air/fuel ratio is theoretically constant at all firing rates. The regulators typically used in these systems are referred to as **zero-pressure regulators**, **zero governors**, or **negative-pressure regulators**. The air restriction may be located upstream or downstream of the blower. An advantage to placing the venturi at the outlet is that the blower does not handle the combustible gas mixture. Placing the venturi at the blower inlet, however, promotes better mixing. Pneumatically linked systems require a minimum pressure drop across the combustion air restriction for the gas regulator to be able to track the airflow accurately. This requirement typically limits the **turndown ratio** (maximum firing rate divided by minimum firing rate) to approximately 5:1.

Electronically linked gas-air ratio burner systems adjust gas flow to match a variable combustion airflow in a manner similar to pneumatically linked systems; however, measurement of airflow and control of gas flow are by electronic means. Typically, such systems measure airflow using a mass flow sensor and adjust gas flow using a throttling valve operated by a stepper motor (in some cases completely eliminating the need for a gas regulator on the appliance). Oxygen trim and other technologies to infer the actual air/fuel ratio using the combustion air mass flow, along with burner temperature or flame ionization signal, are also coming into commercial use. This technology promises to allow the input and air-fuel ratio to be closely controlled independently of factors, such as altitude, vent length, and even fuel gas composition. In addition, because electronically linked systems do not rely on a minimum combustion air pressure drop to control gas flow, much greater turn-down ratios are theoretically possible than with pneumatic systems.

2.2 RESIDENTIAL APPLIANCES

Boilers

Residential space heating is often done with gas-fired low-pressure steam or hot-water boilers (i.e., steam boilers operating at 100 kPa [gage] or less, or hot-water boilers operating at 1100 kPa [gage] or less with 120°C maximum water temperature). Steam or hot water is distributed to convectors, radiators, floor piping, fan-coils, or other heat transfer devices in the space to be heated. Space temperature control may be by zone, in which case the boiler and distribution system must be able to accommodate reduced-load operation. Burners and combustion systems can be any of the previously described types, and some designs include input rate control. Rules of the U.S. Federal Trade Commission (FTC) and federal law require residential boilers with input rates less than 88 kW to comply with minimum efficiency requirements, following the rating protocol of ASHRAE *Standard* 103. For hot-water boilers, 82% annual fuel utilization efficiency (AFUE) is required; for steam boilers, 80%. For ratings and technical information on rating protocol, see the *AHRI Directory of Certified Product Performance* (ahridirectory.org). Manufacturers' literature also provides technical data and ratings.

Some boilers have low mass and essentially instantaneous response, whereas others have higher water volume and mass, which provides a degree of inherent storage capacity to better handle load change. Both steam and hot-water space-heating boilers are available in models having internal coils for service water heating. These **combination boilers** eliminate the need for a separate water heater, but they must be operated whenever service water may be needed, including times when space heating is not necessary. For a comprehensive discussion of boilers, see Chapter 32.

Forced-Air Furnaces

Central gas-fired, forced-air furnaces are the most common residential space-heating systems in the United States and Canada. Forced-air furnaces are available in configurations for upflow, downflow, and horizontal flow air distribution. Most have induced-draft combustion systems with Bunsen-type burners, and are typically of modular design (i.e., burner and heat exchanger modules are used in multiples to provide appliance models with a range of heating capacities). Some are available with staged or modulated input rate, and some have coordinated control of combustion air and circulating airflow. U.S. federal law require furnaces with firing rates less than 66 kW to meet minimum efficiency ratings; see the National Appliance Energy Conservation Act (NAECA) for details. The recognized rating procedure for furnaces is defined in *Code of Federal Regulations* 10 CFR 430.32, which references ASHRAE *Standard* 103. Federal Trade Commission (FTC) rules require manufacturers to publish AFUE ratings in their literature. In addition, independently certified AFUE ratings are published by organizations such as AHRI (2014). For detailed discussion of furnaces, see Chapter 33.

Water Heaters

In the United States, most residential water heaters are of the storage type (i.e., they have relatively low gas input rates and significant hot-water storage capacity). Typically, a single Bunsen-type burner is applied beneath a flue that rises through the stored

water. Flue gas usually flows by natural draft. ANSI and Canadian Standards Association (CSA) appliance standards limit the input rate of these heaters to 22 kW and require that water heaters manufactured since mid-2003 be designed to be **flammable vapor ignition resistant (FVIR)** because water heaters are often installed in garages and should not be an ignition source in case gasoline or other volatile or flammable substances may be present.

Instantaneous water heaters, often designed for mounting to a wall, are characterized by low water storage capacity and low mass, and have special burners and control systems designed for immediate response to demand for hot water. Burner input rate is typically linked to water flow rate and temperature, often by both hydraulic and electronic mechanisms. Because there is no storage, input rates tend to be higher than for storage heaters, and must be adequate for instantaneous demand. Standby losses of instantaneous water heaters are typically less than those of storage heaters. However, U.S. water use habits favor storage water heaters, which are used more extensively throughout the country.

In the United States, the efficiency of residential storage-type water heaters is based on a Department of Energy (DOE) protocol that requires measurement of energy consumption over a 24 h period, during which prescribed amounts of heated water are drawn. An **energy factor** E_f is calculated from the measurements. The rating accounts for standby losses (i.e., heat lost from stored hot water by conduction and convection through tank walls, flue, and pipe fittings to the environment). Hot-water delivery flow also appears in ratings. For storage heaters, the **first-hour rating** (i.e., volume of water that can be drawn in the first hour of use) is provided. For instantaneous heaters, the **maximum flow rate** in litres per second is provided. See AHRI (2007) for ratings and details about the energy factor.

Combination Space- and Water-Heating Appliances

Residential appliances that provide both space and water heating are available in a variety of configurations. One configuration consists of a specially designed storage water heater that heats and stores water for washing activities or for use as a heat transfer medium in a space-heating fan-coil unit. Another configuration, common in Europe and Asia, is a wall-hung boiler that provides hot water for use in either mode. Storage or instantaneous heating capacity must be adequate to meet user demand for showers or other peak activity. Control systems normally prioritize hot-water consumption requirements over the need for space heating, which is allowed only when the hot-water demand has been satisfied. Descriptions and technical data for these and other configurations are available from manufacturers. Ratings are provided in a special section of AHRI (2007). The method for testing and rating of combination space and water heating appliances is specified in ASHRAE *Standard* 124.

Pool Heaters

Pool heaters are a special type of water heater designed specifically for handling high flow rates of water at relatively low water temperature. Various burner and combustion system approaches are used in pool heaters. Input rate control is not normally incorporated because swimming pools are of very high mass and do not change temperature rapidly. Consult manufacturer and pool industry technical data for pool heater selection and application factors.

Conversion Burners

Conversion burners are complete burner and control units designed for installation in existing boilers and furnaces. Atmospheric conversion burners may have drilled-port, slotted-port, or single-port burner heads. These burners are either upshot or inshot types. Figure 8 shows a typical atmospheric upshot gas conversion burner.

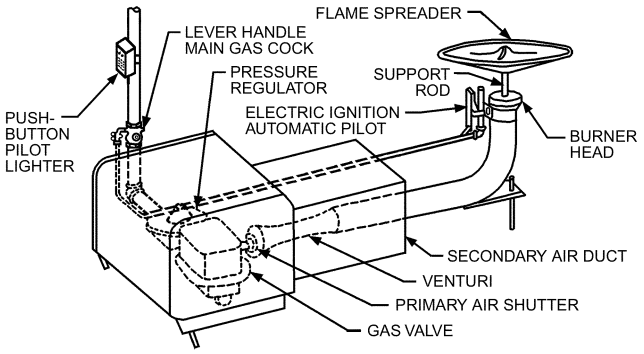


Fig. 8 Typical Single-Port Upshot Gas Conversion Burner

Several power burners are available in residential sizes. These are of gun-burner design and are desirable for furnaces or boilers with restricted flue passages or with downdraft passages.

Conversion burners for domestic application are available in sizes ranging from 12 to 120 kW input, the maximum rate being set by ANSI *Standard* Z21.17/CSA 2.7. However, large gas conversion burners for applications such as apartment building heating may have input rates as high as 260 kW or more.

Successful and safe performance of a gas conversion burner depends on numerous factors other than those incorporated in the appliance, so installations must be made in strict accordance with current ANSI *Standard* Z21.8. Draft hoods conforming to current ANSI *Standard* Z21.12 should also be installed (in place of the dampers used with solid fuel) on all boilers and furnaces converted to burn gas. Because of space limitations, a converted appliance with a breeching over 300 mm in diameter is often fitted with a double-swing barometric regulator instead of a draft hood.

2.3 COMMERCIAL-INDUSTRIAL APPLIANCES

Boilers

Boilers for commercial and industrial application can be very large, both in physical size and input rate. Virtually any requirement for space heating or other process can be met by large boilers or multiple boilers. The heated medium can be water or steam. (See Chapter 32 for extensive discussion.)

Space Heaters

A wide variety of appliances is available for large air-heating applications. Some of them heat air by means of hot-water coils and are used in conjunction with boilers. Some accomplish space heating by means of a fuel-fired heat exchanger. Others fire directly into the heated space.

Forced-air fuel-burning furnaces for commercial and industrial application are essentially like those for residential use, but have larger heating and air-handling capacity. Input rates for single furnaces certified under ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA *Standard* 2.3 may be as high as 117 kW. High capacity can also be provided by parallel (twinned) application of two furnaces. Most manufacturers provide kits to facilitate and address the special safety, mechanical, and control issues posed by twinned application. See manufacturer data and Chapter 33 for additional information about forced-air furnaces and their application.

Duct furnaces are fuel-fired appliances for placement in field-assembled systems with separate air-moving means. Combustion products heat air through heat exchangers mounted in the airstream. The combustion components, heat exchangers, and controls are prepackaged in a cabinet suitable for mounting in a duct system. For proper operation of the duct furnace, the airflow rate must be within

the range specified by the manufacturer. See manufacturer data and Chapter 33 for additional information.

Unit heaters are free-standing appliances for heating large spaces without ductwork. They are often placed overhead, positioned to direct heat to specific areas. Typically, they incorporate fuel-fired heat exchangers and a fan or blower to move air through the exchangers and into the space. However, in some designs the fuel-fired exchangers are replaced by air-heating coils using hot water as the heating medium. Chapter 28 provides further information on unit heaters.

Direct gas-fired makeup-air heaters do not have heat exchangers. They heat large spaces by firing combustion products directly into the space, accompanied by a large quantity of dilution airflow. They have special burners capable of operation in high airflow and controls that allow operation over a wide fuel input rate range. As their name implies, they are used in applications requiring heated makeup air in conjunction with building exhaust systems. (See Chapter 28 for additional information.)

Infrared heaters radiate heat directly to surfaces and objects in a space. Air may be heated by convective heat transfer from the objects. They are suitable for overall heating of a building, but their selection is often based on their ability to radiate heat directly to people in limited areas without intentionally heating items or air in the space, such as in work stations in large open spaces that are not otherwise heated. Indirect infrared heaters use a radiating surface, such as a tube, between the combustion products and the space. Direct infrared heaters use the burner surface, typically a glowing ceramic or metal matrix, as the radiator. Chapter 16 provides additional information. See also manufacturers' data.

Water Heaters

Large-load water-heating applications, such as for large residence buildings, schools and hospitals, restaurants, and industrial processes, require water-heating appliances with correspondingly high fuel input rates, usually in conjunction with substantial hot-water storage. Large tank-type heaters with multiple flues are used in many intermediate-sized applications. They may operate as natural-draft systems, but forced- and induced-draft designs are common. Large applications or those with very high short-term water draw are often handled by means of large unfired storage tanks in conjunction with water-tube or other low-volume, high-input heaters. Fan-assisted combustion systems are increasingly common in those heaters. Premix burners may be used mainly to help meet emissions restrictions. Chapter 51 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* extensively discusses water-heating issues and appliances. ASHRAE *Standards* 118.1 and 118.2 provide methods of testing for rating commercial and residential water heaters, respectively.

Pool Heaters

Fuel-fired pool heaters are available in very large sizes, with fuel input rates ranging to more than 1000 kW. They are designed to handle low-temperature water at high flow rates, and have sensitive temperature controls to ensure swimmer comfort and energy efficiency. Heating pool water with appliances not designed for that purpose can result in severe problems with combustion product condensation, corrosion, and/or scaling. See manufacturers' data for complete information.

2.4 APPLICATIONS

Gas-burning appliances cannot perform as intended unless they are properly installed and set up. Once an appliance of appropriate type, size, and features is selected, the location, fuel supply, air for combustion and ventilation, and venting must be considered and specified correctly. Other factors, notably elevation above sea level, must also be considered and handled.

Location

Listed appliances are provided with rating plate and installation information, with explicit requirements for location. The required clearance to combustible material is particularly important, to eliminate the hazard of fire caused by overheating. Other requirements may be less obvious. Adequate space must be provided for connecting ductwork, piping, and wiring, and for convenient maintenance and service. There must be access to chimneys and vents, and vent terminal locations must comply with specific requirements for safe discharge of combustion products without injury to people or damage to surroundings. Outdoor appliances must be located in consideration of wind effects and similar factors.

Local building codes provide basic rules for unlisted appliances and may impose additional requirements on listed appliances.

Gas Supply and Piping

Natural Gas. Natural gas is usually provided by the local gas utility. Most North American utilities provide substantial and reliable supply pressure, but it is important to verify adequate supply pressure during maximum simultaneous gas consumption by all appliances sharing the supply, and to design adequate supply piping between the utility supply point and the gas-burning appliance. On listed appliances, rating plates specify the minimum supply pressures at which the appliances will operate safely and as intended. This information is also provided in installation instructions, and is available from manufacturers before purchasing appliances.

Gas piping between the utility company meter and the appliance must provide adequate pressure when all concurrent loads operate at their maximum rate. Tables provided in ANSI *Standard* Z223.1/NFPA *Standard* 54 (*National Fuel Gas Code*), CSA *Standard* B149.1, local codes, and elsewhere provide procedures for ensuring adequate pressure. For residential and light commercial services, utility companies typically provide gas at 1.75 kPa. Building distribution piping is usually designed for a full-load pressure drop of less than 75 or 125 Pa. Industrial and large-building applications are often supplied with gas at higher pressures; in that case, the distribution piping can be designed for larger pressure drop, but the end result must supply pressure to an individual appliance within the range required by its manufacturer. A pressure regulator may be required at the appliance to reduce pressure to comply with the rating plate pressure requirement.

Liquefied Petroleum Gas (LPG). LPG can contain a range of gas components. If it is not commercial propane or butane, the actual composition must be ascertained and accommodated. LPG is stored on site as a liquid at moderate pressure; it is vaporized as gas is drawn. A pressure regulator at the tank reduces pressure for distribution to the appliance through piping, subject to the same considerations as for natural gas. In the United States and Canada, normal supply pressure for residential and light commercial applications is 2.75 kPa. Appliance rating plates and installation instructions typically require that supply pressure be maintained at or near that level. Piping must be designed to ensure adequate pressure when concurrent connected loads operate at their maximum input rates.

An important but sometimes overlooked issue is the need to provide heat to vaporize liquefied petroleum in the tank to deliver gas. In most residential applications, heat for vaporization is simply taken from outdoor air through the tank walls. This natural heat source may become inadequate, however, as the air temperature falls, draw rate increases, or tank liquid level falls. Commercial propane and butane have boiling point temperatures of –42°C and 0°C, respectively. As the LPG tank approaches the boiling point temperature, tank pressure falls to the point where the gas cannot be supplied at the required rate. In these cases and in high-demand applications, supplemental heat may be necessary to vaporize LPG. Information on selection and application of vaporization equipment is available from LPG dealers

and distributors, from the National Propane Gas Association, and in various codes and standards.

Air for Combustion and Ventilation

In application of fuel-burning appliances, inadequate provision of air for combustion and ventilation is a serious mistake. In the worst scenario, shortage of combustion air results in incomplete combustion and production of poisonous carbon monoxide, which can kill. Inadequate ventilation of the space in which an appliance is installed can result in high ambient temperatures that stress the appliance itself or other appliances or materials in the vicinity. For those reasons, building codes and manufacturers' installation instructions include requirements for combustion and ventilation air supply. Requirements vary, with several factors having to do with how easily air can get to the appliance from the outdoors. Infiltration is seldom adequate, and it is usually necessary to provide dedicated means for supply of air for combustion and ventilation. In cold regions, take measures to prevent freezing of water pipes and other equipment by cold air in the appliance space. For more information, see Ackerman et al. (1995) and Dale et al. (1997).

Draft Control

Natural-draft appliances typically include a **draft hood** or **diverter** to decouple the combustion system from undesirable draft effects, notably the draft or pull of the chimney. These devices provide a path for dilution air to mix with flue gas before entering the connector between the appliance and the chimney, and to accommodate updraft and downdraft variations that occur in the field because of wind. A **barometric draft control** is a similar device that uses a damper to control the flow of dilution air into the vent. The damper of a barometric draft control can be manually adjusted to regulate the draft imposed on the appliance. Often, this is accomplished with special weights, in conjunction with measurement with a draft gage. Draft controls should be supplied by the appliance manufacturer as part of the appliance combustion controls. See Chapter 35 for design considerations for vent and chimney draft control.

Venting

Safety and technical factors must be considered in venting appliances, including some less obvious considerations. Consequences of incorrect venting are very serious, and can include production of lethal carbon monoxide, spilling of heat and combustion moisture indoors, and deterioration of the vent or chimney caused by condensation of water vapor from vent gas. High-efficiency appliances can produce combustion products at temperatures near or below their dew point. Venting those flue gases requires use of special materials and installation practices, and provision for condensate drainage and disposal.

Comprehensive guidance for design of venting systems is provided in Chapter 35. For many North American gas-fired appliances, however, ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA *Standard* 2.3 and ANSI *Standard* 21.13/CSA *Standard* 4.9 require categorization by the type of vent system necessary for safe and effective operation. Appliances are tested to determine the temperature and pressure of vent gas released into the vent. The categories, which apply only to appliances design-certified as complying with standards having category specifications, are as follows:

Category	Vent Static Pressure	Vent Gas Temperature High Enough to Avoid Excessive Condensate Production in Vent?
I	Nonpositive	Yes
II	Nonpositive	No
III	Positive	Yes
IV	Positive	No

Category I and II appliances with a forced- or induced-draft blower to move combustion air and combustion products through the appliance flue create no pressure at the appliance flue exit (entrance to the venting system), and therefore do not augment draft in the vent.

Most local building codes include vent sizing tables and requirements that must be used for design of venting systems for category I appliances. Those tables are adopted from the *National Fuel Gas Code*, which distinguishes between appliances with draft hoods and appliances having fan-assisted combustion systems without draft hoods. In both cases, vent gases flow into the vent at category I conditions, but there is less dilution air with fan-assisted appliances than with draft-hood-equipped appliances. Vent gas flow and condensation tendencies differ accordingly. The tables specify

- Maximum (NAT Max) input rates for single-appliance vent systems and multiple-appliance vent connectors of given sizes for draft hood-equipped appliances
- Minimum (Fan Min) and maximum (Fan Max) input rates for single-appliance vent systems and multiple-appliance vent connectors of given sizes for fan-assisted appliances
- Maximum (Fan + NAT) input rates for multiple-appliance common vents of given sizes for combinations of draft-hood-equipped and fan-assisted appliance systems
- Maximum (Fan + Fan) input rates for multiple-appliance common vents of given sizes for fan-assisted appliance systems

Category II appliances are rare because it is difficult to vent low-temperature flue gas by its own buoyancy. Category III and IV appliances, with positive vent pressure, are common. Those appliances must be vented in accordance with the manufacturers' installation instructions, and require special venting materials. Category II and IV appliances also require venting designs that provide for collection and disposal of condensate. Condensate tends to be corrosive and may require treatment.

Appliances designed for installation with piping and terminals for both venting of flue gas and intake of combustion air directly to the appliance are called **direct-vent** (and sometimes, erroneously, **sealed combustion**) systems. (Sealed combustion systems take combustion air from outside the space being heated, not necessarily outdoors, and all flue gases are discharged outdoors; this is not a balanced system.) The vent and combustion air intake terminals of direct-vent appliances should be located outdoors, close to each other, so that they form a balanced system that is not adversely affected by winds from various directions. Vent pipe and combustion air intake pipe materials are provided or specified by the appliance manufacturer, and their use is mandatory. A variation in which only vent materials are specified, with combustion air taken directly from inside the conditioned space, is referred to as a **direct-exhaust** system. Most category III and IV systems are direct-vent or direct-exhaust systems.

Unlisted appliances must be vented in accordance with local building codes and the manufacturers' installation instructions. Clearance from vent piping to combustible material, mechanical support of vent piping, and similar requirements are also included in local codes.

Building Depressurization

Appliance operation can be affected by operation of other appliances and equipment in the building that change building pressure with respect to outdoor pressure. Building pressure can be reduced by bathroom and kitchen exhaust fans, cooktop range downdraft exhausters, clothes dryers, fireplaces, other fuel-burning appliances, and other equipment that removes air from the building. If building pressure is significantly lower than outdoor pressure, venting flue gases to the outdoors might be adversely affected and potentially hazardous combustion products may be spilled into the inhabited space, especially from category I and II appliances. Category III and IV appliances are less susceptible to venting and spillage problems,

because these appliances produce pressure to force the flue gases through their vents to the outdoors. In addition, direct-vent appliances of all vent categories take their combustion air directly from the outdoors, which makes them even less susceptible to building depressurization. Wind can produce building depressurization, if building infiltration and exfiltration are unfavorably imbalanced.

Gas Input Rate

Gas input rate is the rate of heat energy input to an appliance, measured in kilowatts.

The unit heating value of the fuel gas is expressed in megajoules per cubic metre. In North America, **higher heating value (HHV)** is commonly used to specify the heat available from gas when combusted. HHV includes all of the heat available by burning fuel gas delivered at 15.0°C and 101.325 kPa (i.e., standard conditions for the gas industry in North America) when combustion products are cooled to 15.0°C and water vapor formed during combustion is condensed at 15.0°C. (*Note*: Standard conditions of 15.0°C and 101.325 kPa [see the section on U.S. Standard Atmosphere in Chapter 1 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*] are slightly different from the standard conditions of 60°F [15.56°C] and 14.735 psia [30.00 in. Hg, or 101.594 kPa] used by the gas industry in North America and in the I-P version of this chapter.) See Chapter 28 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for more information on HHV.

In practical laboratory or field situations, fuel gas is not delivered at standard conditions. Determination of appliance input rate must include compensation for the actual temperature and pressure conditions.

In the laboratory, gas input rate is calculated with the following equation:

$$Q = 0.2778\text{HHV} \times \text{VFR} \times \frac{(T_s \times P)}{(T \times P_s)}$$

where

Q = gas input rate, kW

HHV = gas higher heating value at standard temperature and pressure, MJ/m^3

VFR = fuel gas volumetric flow rate at meter temperature and pressure, m^3/h

T_s = standard temperature, 288.15 K (15.0°C + 273.15 K)

P = fuel gas pressure in gas meter, kPa

T = absolute temperature of fuel gas in meter, K (fuel gas temperature in °C + 273.15 K)

P_s = standard pressure, 101.325 kPa

Example 1. Calculate the gas input rate for 38.00 MJ/m^3 HHV fuel gas, 24.0°C fuel gas temperature, 97.788 kPa barometer pressure (300.0 m altitude), 2.8 m^3/h of fuel gas volumetric flow rate clocked at the meter with 1.7 kPa fuel gas pressure in the gas meter.

$$P = B + P_f$$

where

B = local barometric pressure, kPa

P_f = fuel gas pressure in gas meter, kPa

P = 97.788 kPa + 1.7 kPa = 99.488 kPa

T = 24.0°C + 273.15 K = 297.15 K

Thus,

$$Q = \frac{0.2778 \text{ kWh}}{\text{MJ}} \times \frac{38.00 \text{ MJ/m}^3 \times 2.800 \text{ m}^3\text{/h} \times (288.15 \text{ K} \times 99.488 \text{ kPa})}{297.15 \text{ K} \times 101.325 \text{ kPa}}$$

$$= 28.143 \text{ kW gas input rate}$$

In the field, input can be measured in two ways:

- With a gas meter, usually furnished by the gas supplier at the gas entrance point to a building
- By using the appliance burner gas injector (orifice) size and the manifold pressure (pressure drop through the injector [orifice])

Gas input rate is calculated with the following equation, when fuel gas volumetric flow rate is measured using the gas supplier's meter.

$$Q = 0.2778\text{HC} \times \text{VFR}$$

where

Q = gas input rate, kW

0.2778 = conversion factor, MJ/h to kW

HC = local gas heat content, MJ/m^3

VFR = fuel gas volumetric flow rate, m^3/h

Effect of Gas Temperature and Barometric Pressure Changes on Gas Input Rate

In the field, gas temperature is typically unknown, but is sometimes assumed to be a standard temperature such as 15.0°C (15.6°C or 60°F in North America); some meters have built-in temperature compensation to that temperature. Some gas suppliers also tabulate data for both local barometric pressure and local metering pressure. Add the meter gage pressure to the barometric pressure to get a correct fuel-gas absolute pressure. This methodology is used in ANSI Z *Standard* 223.1/NFPA *Standard* 54 (*National Fuel Gas Code*), sections 11.1.1, 11.1.2, and A.11.1.1, and Table A.11.1.1.

Also see the installation codes in the references for methods for using gas meters and for using injector (orifice) size with pressure drop to measure fuel gas flow rate.

Fuel Gas Interchangeability

Gas-burning appliances are normally set up for operation at their rated input with fuel gas of specified properties. Because fuel gases vary greatly, other gases cannot be substituted indiscriminately.

In most gas appliances, input rate is controlled by establishing a specified gas pressure difference (often referred to as **manifold pressure**) across one or more precisely sized orifices. Per the Bernoulli equation, gas velocity through the orifice is proportional to the square root of the pressure difference and inversely proportional to the square root of the density. The input rate also depends on the heat content of the gas and orifice size. Simplified to the basics, it is expressed as follows for particular conditions of temperature and barometric pressure:

$$Q = K \times \text{HHV} \times D_o^2 \sqrt{\frac{P_m}{\text{SG}}} \quad (1)$$

where

Q = input rate, kW

K = constant accounting for measurement units, orifice discharge coefficient, and atmospheric conditions

HHV = gas higher heating value, MJ/m^3

D_o = orifice diameter, mm

P_m = manifold pressure, Pa

SG = gas specific gravity, dimensionless

If a substitute gas is introduced, only the higher heating value and specific gravity change. The orifice diameter, manifold pressure, and factors accounted for in the constant K do not change. Therefore, the new input is directly proportional to the gas higher heating value and inversely proportional to the square root of the specific gravity:

$$\frac{Q_2}{Q_1} = \left(\frac{\text{HHV}_2}{\sqrt{\text{SG}_2}}\right) \Big/ \left(\frac{\text{HHV}_1}{\sqrt{\text{SG}_1}}\right) \quad (2)$$

where subscripts 1 and 2 indicate the original and substitute gases, respectively. The ratio of higher heating value to the square root of the specific gravity has been named the **Wobbe index** W. The units of the Wobbe index are the same as those of the heating value because the specific gravity is dimensionless. Substituting for Wobbe index,

$$\frac{\text{HHV}}{\sqrt{\text{SG}}} = W \tag{3}$$

$$\frac{Q_2}{Q_1} = \frac{W_2}{W_1} \tag{4}$$

$$Q_2 = Q_1 \frac{W_2}{W_1} \tag{5}$$

In other words, when one gas is substituted for another in an appliance and no other changes are made, the input rate changes in proportion to their Wobbe indices. Preservation of input rate does not necessarily ensure proper operation of an appliance, however. Ignition and burning characteristics can differ significantly for gases that have the same Wobbe index. To ensure safe, efficient operation, appliance manufacturers typically limit the range of gases that may be used.

Converting an appliance for use with a gas substantially different from the gas it was originally set up for requires changing the gas-handling components and/or adjustments. Typical natural gas and commercial propane, for example, have Wobbe indices of about 50 and 76 MJ/m^3, respectively. Based on that difference, substituting propane in an unaltered natural gas appliance results in overfiring of the appliance by about 53%, leading to appliance overheating and high production of soot and carbon monoxide. To accommodate the change, it is necessary to change the gas orifice size and, usually, the gas pressure regulator setting to achieve the same gas input rate. Acceptable performance may require additional appliance modifications to avoid other problems (e.g., resonance, poor flame carryover between ganged burners) that manufacturers must identify and resolve. The components necessary for conversion are normally provided by the appliance manufacturer, along with instructions for their installation and checkout of appliance operation.

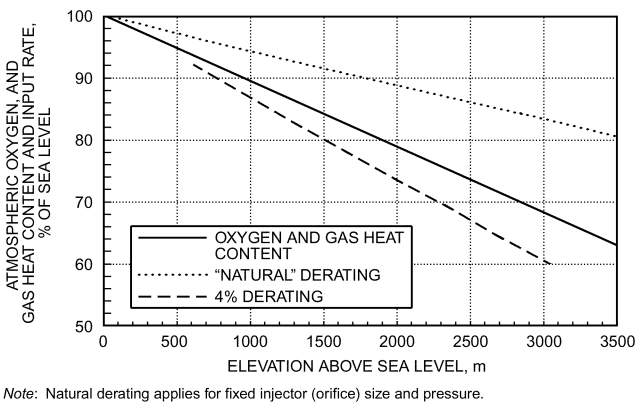
Natural gas is increasingly being transported across oceans as **liquefied natural gas (LNG)**, shipped at high pressure and low temperature in specially designed ships. It is regasified in facilities at the destination, then distributed by utilities in conventional pipelines and service piping. Depending on the characteristics of a utility's existing gas supply, LNG can differ significantly in its mix of various hydrocarbons, inert gases, etc., and its burning characteristics may be of concern relative to the existing gas. Depending on the extent of the difference, a utility may mix it with other components to improve its compatibility with the existing appliance load. The Wobbe index is useful in evaluating the need for such accommodation.

Altitude

When gas-fired appliances are operated at altitudes substantially above sea level, three notable effects occur:

- Oxygen available for combustion is reduced in proportion to the atmospheric pressure reduction
- With gaseous fuels, the heat of combustion per unit volume of fuel gas (gas heat content) is reduced because of reduced fuel gas density in proportion to the atmospheric pressure reduction
- Reduced air density affects the performance and operating temperature of heat exchangers and appliance cooling mechanisms

In addition to reducing the gas heat content of fuel gas, reduced fuel gas density also causes increased gas velocity through flow metering orifices. The net effect is for gas input rate to decrease naturally with increases in altitude, but at less than the rate at which atmospheric oxygen decreases. This effect is one reason that derating is required when appliances are operated at altitudes significantly above sea level. Early research by American Gas Association Laboratories with draft hood-equipped appliances established that appliance input rates should be reduced at the rate of 4% per 305 m above sea level, for altitudes higher than 610 m above sea level (Figure 9).



Note: Natural derating applies for fixed injector (orifice) size and pressure.

Fig. 9 Altitude Effects on Gas Combustion Appliances

Experience with recently developed appliances having fan-assisted combustion systems demonstrated that the 4% rule may not apply in all cases. It is therefore important to consult the manufacturer's listed appliance installation instructions, which are based on both how the combustion system operates and other factors such as impaired heat transfer. Note also that manufacturers of appliances having tracking-type burner systems may not require derating at altitudes above 610 m. In those systems, fuel gas and combustion airflow are affected in the same proportion by density reduction.

In terms of end use, it is important for the appliance specifier to be aware that the heating capacity of appliances is substantially reduced at altitudes significantly above sea level. To ensure adequate delivery of heat, derating of heating capacity must also be considered and quantified.

By definition, fuel gas HHV value remains constant for all altitudes because it is based on standard conditions of 101.325 kPa and 15.0°C (288.15 K). Some fuel gas suppliers at high altitudes (e.g., at Denver, Colorado, at 1525 m) may report fuel gas heat content at local barometric pressure instead of standard pressure. Local gas heat content can be calculated using the following equation:

$$\text{HC} = \text{HHV} \times \frac{B}{P_s}$$

where

HC = local gas heat content at local barometric pressure and standard temperature conditions, MJ/m^3
HHV = gas higher heating value at standard temperature and pressure of 15.0°C (288.15 K) and 101.325 kPa, respectively, MJ/m^3
B = local barometric pressure, kPa (not corrected to sea level: do not use barometric pressure as reported by weather forecasters, because it is corrected to sea level)
P_s = standard pressure = 101.325 kPa

For example, at 1525 m, the barometric pressure is 84.316 kPa. If HHV of a fuel gas sample is 37.5 MJ/m^3 (at standard temperature and pressure), the local gas heat content would be 31.21 MJ/m^3 at 84.316 kPa barometric pressure 1525 m above sea level.

$$\text{HC} = 37.5 \text{ MJ/m}^3 \times 84.316 \text{ kPa}/101.325 \text{ kPa} = 31.21 \text{ MJ/m}^3$$

Therefore, the local gas heat content of a sample of fuel gas can be expressed as 31.21 MJ/m^3 at local barometric pressure of 84.316 kPa and standard temperature or as 37.5 MJ/m^3 (HHV). Both gas heat

contents are correct, but the application engineer must understand the difference to use each one correctly. As described earlier, the local heat content HC can be used to determine appliance input rate.

When gas heat value (either HHV or HC) is used to determine gas input rate, the gas pressure and temperature in the meter must also be considered. Add the gage pressure of gas in the meter to the local barometric pressure to calculate the heat content of the gas at the pressure in the meter. The gas temperature in the meter also affects the heat content of the gas in the meter. The gas heat value is directly proportional to the gas pressure and inversely proportional to its absolute temperature in accordance with the perfect gas laws, as illustrated in the following example calculations for gas input rate with either the HHV or the local heat content.

Example 2. Calculate the gas input rate for 37.5 MJ/m^3 HHV fuel gas, 2.800 m^3/h volumetric flow rate of 24°C fuel gas at 84.316 kPa barometer pressure (1525 m altitude) with 1.700 kPa (gage) fuel gas gage pressure in the gas meter.

HHV Method:

$$Q = 0.2778\text{HHV} \times \text{VFR}_s$$

where

Q = fuel gas input rate, kW
0.2778=conversion factor, MJ/h to kW
HHV= fuel gas higher heating value at standard temperature and pressure, MJ/m^3
VFR_s=fuel gas volumetric flow rate adjusted to standard temperature and pressure, m^3/h
= $\text{VFR}(T_s \times P)/(T \times P_s)$
VFR= fuel gas volumetric flow rate at local temperature and pressure conditions, m^3/h
T_s = standard temperature, 288.15 K (15.0°C + 273.15 K)
P = gas meter absolute pressure, kPa (local barometer pressure + gas pressure in meter relative to barometric pressure)
= 84.316 kPa + 1.700 kPa = 86.016 kPa gas meter absolute pressure
T = absolute temperature of fuel gas, K (fuel gas temperature in °C + 273.15 K)
P_s = standard pressure, 101.325 kPa

Substituting given values into the equation for VFR_s gives

$$\text{VFR}_s = \frac{2.800\ \text{m}^3/\text{h} \times 288.15\ \text{K} \times 86.016\ \text{kPa}}{(24.00°\text{C} + 273.15\ \text{K})101.325\ \text{kPa}} = 2.305\ \text{m}^3/\text{h}$$

Then,

$$Q = 0.2778 \times 37.5\ \text{MJ/m}^3 \times 2.305\ \text{m}^3/\text{h} = 24.012\ \text{kW}$$

Local Gas Heat Content Method: The local gas heat content is simply the HHV adjusted to local gas meter pressure and temperature conditions. The gas input rate is simply the observed volumetric gas flow rate times the local gas heat content.

$$Q = 0.2778\text{HC} \times \text{VFR}$$

where

Q = gas input rate, kW
0.2778=conversion factor, MJ/h to kW
HC = gas heat content at local gas meter pressure and temperature conditions, MJ/m^3
= $\text{HHV}(T_s \times P)/(T \times P_s)$
VFR = fuel gas volumetric flow rate, referenced to local gas meter pressure and temperature conditions, m^3/h
T_s = standard temperature, 288.15 K (15.00°C + 273.15 K)
P = gas meter absolute pressure, kPa (local barometer pressure + gas pressure in gas meter relative to barometric pressure)
P_s = standard pressure = 101.325 kPa
B = local barometric pressure = 84.316 kPa
T = absolute temperature of fuel gas, 297.15 K (24.00°C fuel gas temperature + 273.15 K)

Substituting given values into the equation for HC gives

$$\text{HC} = \frac{37.5 \times 288.15(84.316 + 1.700)}{297.15 \times 101.325} = 30.87\ \text{MJ/m}^3$$

Then,

$$Q = 0.2778 \times 30.87\ \text{MJ/m}^3 \times 2.800\ \text{m}^3/\text{h} = 24.012\ \text{kW}$$

The gas input rate is exactly the same for both calculation methods.

3. OIL-BURNING APPLIANCES

An oil burner is a mechanical device for preparing fuel oil to combine with air under controlled conditions for combustion. Fuel oil is atomized at a controlled flow rate. Air for combustion is generally supplied with a forced-draft fan, although natural or mechanically induced draft can be used. Ignition is typically provided by an electric spark, although gas pilot flames, oil pilot flames, and hot-surface igniters may also be used. Oil burners operate from automatic temperature- or pressure-sensing controls.

Oil burners may be classified by application, type of atomizer, or firing rate. They can be divided into two major groups: residential and commercial/industrial. Further distinction is made based on design and operation; different types include pressure atomizing, air or steam atomizing, rotary, vaporizing, and mechanical atomizing. Unvented, portable kerosene heaters are not classified as residential oil burners or as oil heat appliances.

3.1 RESIDENTIAL OIL BURNERS

Residential oil burners ordinarily consume fuel at a rate of 0.5 to 3.7 mL/s, corresponding to input rates of about 20 to 150 kW. However, burners up to 3.7 mL/s (about 300 kW input) sometimes fall in the residential classification because of basic similarities in controls and standards. (Burners with a capacity of 7.4 mL/s and above are classified as commercial/industrial.) No. 2 fuel oil is generally used, although burners in the residential size range can also operate on No. 1 fuel oil. Burners in the 0.5 to 2.5 mL/s range are used not only for boilers and furnaces for space heating, but also for separate tank-type residential water heaters, infrared heaters, space heaters, and other commercial appliances.

Central heating appliances include warm-air furnaces and steam or hot water boilers. Oil-burning furnaces and boilers operate essentially the same way as their gas counterparts. NFPA *Standard* 31 prescribes correct installation practices for oil-burning appliances.

Steam or hot-water boilers are available in cast iron and steel. In addition to supplying space heating, many boilers are designed to provide hot water using tankless integral or external heat exchangers. Residential boilers designed to operate as direct-vent appliances are available.

Over 95% of residential burners manufactured today are high-pressure atomizing gun burners with retention-type heads (Figure 10). This type of burner supplies oil to the atomizing nozzle at pressures that range from 700 to 2100 kPa. A fan supplies air for combustion, and generally an inlet damper regulates the air supply at the burner. A high-voltage electric spark ignites the fuel by either **constant ignition** (on when the burner motor is on) or **interrupted ignition** (on only to start combustion). Typically, these burners fire into a combustion chamber in which draft is maintained. Increasingly, however, these burners are being fired into applications (including direct-vent and high-efficiency condensing applications) that have a low level of positive combustion chamber pressure.

Modern retention-head oil burners use 3450 rpm motors, and their fans achieve a maximum static pressure of about 750 Pa. Older residential oil burners, which can still be found in the field, used lower-speed motors (1750 rpm) and achieved a maximum static pressure of about 250 to 375 Pa. With higher fan static pressure, burner airflow is less sensitive to variations in appliance draft conditions. Higher-static-pressure burners operate better in applica-

tions with positive combustion chamber pressure. In many cases, these burners can be operated without a flue draft regulator.

Traditionally, oil burners are operated with a fuel pressure of 700 kPa, and burners' nozzles are all rated for firing rate and spray angle at this pressure. Increasingly higher pressures (900 to 1050 kPa) are specified by manufacturers for some burners and applications, to achieve better atomization and combustion performance (Figure 11). Nozzle fuel firing rate increases in proportion to the square root of the fuel pressure.

Oil nozzle line heaters are used in some applications. These are very small electric heaters located adjacent to the nozzle adapter and typically integrated with the burner. These include positive-temperature-coefficient heaters that self-regulate to achieve a fuel temperature in the 50 to 65°C range. Heating fuel in this way improves atomization quality and reduces fuel firing rate.

Electric fuel solenoid valves may be installed in the fuel line between the fuel pump and the nozzle and may be mounted directly on the fuel pump. These valves serve to provide sharp fuel flow starts and stops during cyclic operation and augment the function of the fuel pump and pressure-operated flow control valves. In addition, solenoid valves can be used to achieve pre- and post-purge operation in which the burner motor runs to provide purge airflow through the burner and appliance. The post purge can be useful in reducing nozzle temperatures after shutdown and preventing odors indoors, particularly with non-direct-vent applications.

Pressure-operated valves integrated with oil burner nozzle assemblies are also available. These valves also provide positive fuel cutoff after burner shutdown and avoid after-drip caused by heat transfer from the still-hot combustion chamber to the nozzle assembly and accumulation of fuel vapor pressure in the nozzle assembly and fuel line. When used, these nozzle valves require the fuel pump discharge pressure to be increased, using the integral pump pressure regulator to compensate for the added pressure drop of the valve.

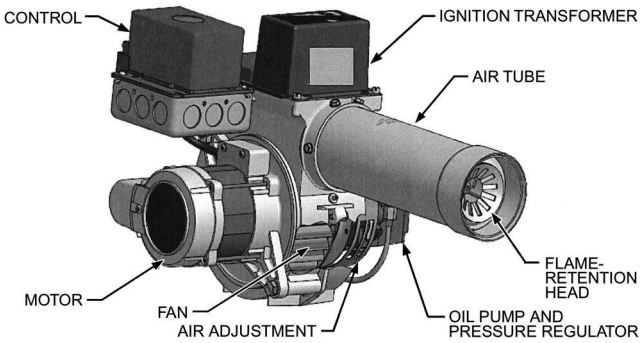


Fig. 10 High-Pressure Atomizing Gun Oil Burner

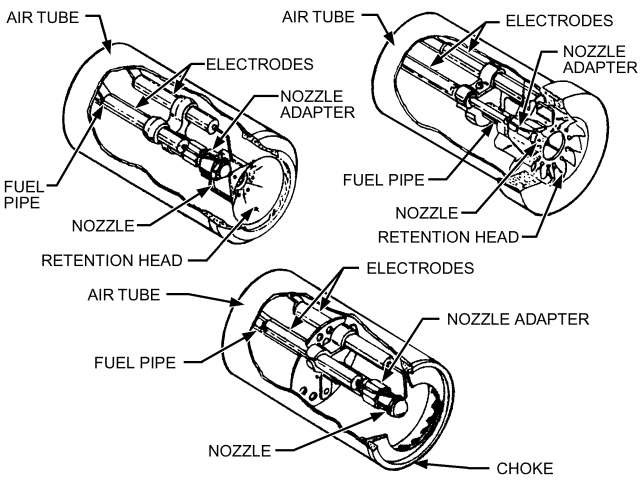


Fig. 11 Details of High-Pressure Atomizing Oil Burner

The following designs are still in operation but are not a significant part of the residential market:

- The low-pressure atomizing gun burner differs from the high-pressure type in that it uses air at a low pressure to atomize oil.
- The pressure atomizing induced-draft burner uses the same type of oil pump, nozzle, and ignition system as the high-pressure atomizing gun burner.
- Vaporizing burners are designed for use with No. 1 fuel oil. Fuel is ignited electrically or by manual pilot.
- Rotary burners are usually of the vertical wall flame type.

Beyond the pressure atomizing burner, considerable developmental effort has been put into advanced technologies such as air atomization, fuel prevaporization, and pulsed fuel flow. Some of these are now used commercially in Europe. Reported benefits include reduced emissions, increased efficiency, and the ability to quickly vary the firing rate. See Locklin and Hazard (1980) for a historical review of technology for residential oil burners. Somewhat more recent developments are described in the *Proceedings of the Oil Heat Technology Conferences and Workshops* (McDonald 1989-2003).

In Europe, there is increasing use of low-NO_x, **blue flame burners** for residential and commercial applications. Peak flame temperatures (and thermal NO_x emissions) are reduced by using high flame zone recirculation rates. In a typical boiler, a conventional yellow flame retention head oil burner has a NO_x emission of 90 to 110 ppm. A blue flame burner emits about 60 ppm. The blue flame burners require flame sensors for the safety control, which responds to the fluctuating light emitted. Blue flame burners are somewhat more expensive than conventional yellow flame burners. See Butcher et al. (1994) for additional discussion of NO_x and small oil burners.

3.2 COMMERCIAL/INDUSTRIAL OIL BURNERS

Commercial and industrial oil burners are designed for use with distillate or residual grades of fuel oil. With slight modifications, burners designed for residual grades can use distillate fuel oils.

The commercial/industrial burners covered here have atomizers, which inject the fuel oil into the combustion space in a fine, conical spray with the apex at the atomizer. The burner also forces combustion air into the oil spray, causing an intimate and turbulent mixing of air and oil. Applied for a predetermined time, an electrical spark, a spark-ignited gas, or an oil igniter ignites the mixture, and sustained combustion takes place. Safety controls are used to shut down the burner upon failure to ignite.

All of these burners can almost completely burn the fuel oil without visible smoke when they are operated with excess air as low as 20% (approximately 12% CO_2 in the flue gases). Atomizing oil burners are generally classified according to the method used for atomizing the oil, such as pressure atomizing, return-flow pressure atomizing, air atomizing, rotary cup atomizing, steam atomizing, mechanical atomizing, or return-flow mechanical atomizing. Descriptions of these burners are given in the following sections, together with usual capacities and applications. Table 1 lists approximate size range, fuel grade, and usual applications. All burners described are available as gas/oil (dual-fuel) burners.

Pressure-Atomizing Oil Burners

This type of burner is used in most installations where No. 2 fuel oil is burned. The oil is pumped at pressures of 700 to 2100 kPa through a suitable burner nozzle orifice that breaks it into a fine mist

Table 1 Classification of Atomizing Oil Burners

Type of Oil Burner	Heat Range, MW	Flow Volume, mL/s	Fuel Grade	Usual Application
Pressure-atomizing	0.02 to 2	0.5 to 50	No. 2 (less than 25 mL/s)	Boilers Warm-air furnaces
			No. 4 (greater than 25 mL/s)	Appliances
Return-flow pressure-atomizing or modulating pressure-atomizing	1 and above	25 and above	No. 2 and heavier	Boilers Warm-air furnaces
Air-atomizing	0.02 to 0.3	0.5 to 7	No. 2 and heavier	Boilers Warm-air furnaces
Horizontal rotary cup	0.2 to 10	5 to 30	No. 2 for small sizes	Boilers
			No. 4, 5, or 6 for larger sizes	Large warm-air furnaces
Steam-atomizing (register-type)	3.5 and above	85 and above	No. 2 and heavier	Boilers
Mechanical atomizing (register-type)	3.5 and above	85 and above	No. 2 and heavier	Boilers Industrial furnaces
Return-flow mechanical atomizing	13 to 50	310 to 1260	No. 2 and heavier	Boilers

and swirls it into the combustion space as a cone-shaped spray. Combustion air from a fan is forced through the burner air-handling parts surrounding the oil nozzle and is directed into the oil spray.

For smaller-capacity burners, ignition is usually started by an electric spark applied near the discharge of the burner nozzle. For burner capacities above 20 mL/s, a spark-ignited gas or an oil igniter is used.

Pressure-atomizing burners are designated commercially as forced-draft, natural-draft, or induced-draft burners. The forced-draft burner has a fan and motor with capacity to supply all combustion air to the combustion chamber or furnace at a pressure high enough to force the gases through the heat-exchange equipment without the assistance of an induced-draft fan or a chimney draft. Mixing of the fuel and air is such that a minimum of refractory material is required in the combustion space or furnace to support combustion. The natural-draft burner requires a draft in the combustion space.

Burner range, or variation in burning rate, is changed by simultaneously varying the oil pressure to the burner nozzle and regulating the airflow by a damper. This range is limited to about 1.6 to 1 for any given nozzle orifice. Burner firing mode controls for various capacity burners differ among manufacturers. Usually, larger burners have controls that provide variable heat inputs. If burner capacity is up to 16 mL/s, a staged control is typically used; if it is up to 25 mL/s, a **modulation control** is typically used. In both cases, the low burning rate is about 60% of the full-load capacity of the burner.

For pressure-atomizing burners, no preheating is required for burning No. 2 oil. No. 4 oil must be preheated to about 38°C for proper burning. When properly adjusted, these burners operate well with less than 20% excess air (approximately 12% CO_2); no visible smoke (approximately No. 2 smoke spot number, as determined by ASTM *Standard* D2156); and only a trace of carbon monoxide in the flue gas in commercial applications. In these applications, the regulation of combustion airflow is typically based on smoke level or flue gas monitoring using analyzers for CO, O_2, or CO_2.

Burners with lower firing rates used to power appliances, residential heating boilers, or warm-air furnaces are usually set up to operate to about 50% excess air (approximately 10% CO_2).

Good operation of these burners calls for (1) a relatively constant draft (either in the furnace or at the breeching connection, depending on the burner selected), (2) clean burner components, and (3) good-quality fuel oil that complies with the appropriate specifications.

Return-Flow Pressure-Atomizing Oil Burners

This burner is a modification of the pressure-atomizing burner; it is also called a modulating-pressure atomizer. It has the advantage of a wide load range for any given atomizer: about 3 to 1 turndown (or variation in load) as compared to 1.6 to 1 for the straight pressure atomizing burner.

This wide range is accomplished by means of a return-flow nozzle, which has an atomizing swirl chamber just ahead of the orifice. Good atomization throughout the load range is attained by maintaining a high rate of oil flow and high pressure drop through the swirl chamber. The excess oil above the load demand is returned from the swirl chamber to the oil storage tank or to the suction of the oil pump.

The burning rate is controlled by varying oil pressure in both the oil inlet and oil return lines. Except for the atomizer, load range, and method of control, the information given for the straight pressure-atomizing burner applies to this burner as well.

Air-Atomizing Oil Burners

Except for the nozzle, this burner is similar in construction to the pressure-atomizing burner. Atomizing air and oil are supplied to individual parts within the nozzle. The nozzle design allows the oil to break up into small droplet form as a result of the shear forces created by the atomizing air. The atomized oil is carried from the nozzle through the outlet orifice by the airflow into the furnace.

The main combustion air from a draft fan is forced through the burner throat and mixes intimately with the oil spray inside the combustion space. The burner igniter is similar to that used on pressure-atomizing burners.

This burner is well suited for heavy fuel oils, including No. 6, and has a wide load range, or turndown, without changing nozzles. Turndown of 3 to 1 for the smaller sizes and about 6 or 8 to 1 for the larger sizes may be expected. Load range is varied by simultaneously varying the oil pressure, the atomizing air pressure, and the combustion air entering the burner. Some designs use relatively low atomizing air pressure (35 kPa and lower); other designs use air pressures up to 520 kPa. The burner uses from 16 to 58 L of compressed air per litre of fuel oil (on an air-free basis).

Because of its wide load range, this burner operates well on modulating control.

No preheating is required for No. 2 fuel oil. The heavier grades of oil must be preheated to maintain proper viscosity for atomization. When properly adjusted, these burners operate well with less than 15 to 25% excess air (approximately 14 to 12% CO_2, respectively, at full load); no visible smoke (approximately No. 2 smoke spot number); and only a trace of carbon monoxide in the flue gas.

Horizontal Rotary Cup Oil Burners

This burner atomizes the oil by spinning it in a thin film from a horizontal rotating cup and injecting high-velocity primary air into the oil film through an annular nozzle that surrounds the rim of the atomizing cup.

The atomizing cup and frequently the primary air fan are mounted on a horizontal main shaft that is motor-driven and rotates at constant speed (58 to 100 r/s) depending on the size and make of the burner. The oil is fed to the atomizing cup at controlled rates from an oil pump that is usually driven from the main shaft through a worm and gear.

A separately mounted fan forces secondary air through the burner windbox. Secondary air should not be introduced by natural draft. The oil is ignited by a spark-ignited gas or an oil-burning igniter (pilot). The load range or turndown for this burner is about 4 to 1, making it well suited for operation with modulating control. Automatic combustion controls are electrically operated.

When properly adjusted, these burners operate well with 20 to 25% excess air (approximately 12.5 to 12% CO_2, respectively, at full load), no visible smoke (approximately No. 2 smoke spot number), and only a trace of carbon monoxide in the flue gas.

This burner is available from several manufacturers as a package comprising burner, primary air fan, secondary air fan with separate motor, fuel oil pump, motor, motor starter, ignition system (including transformer), automatic combustion controls, flame safety equipment, and control panel.

Good operation of these burners requires relatively constant draft in the combustion space. The main assembly of the burner, with motor, main shaft, primary air fan, and oil pump, is arranged for mounting on the boiler front and is hinged so that the assembly can be swung away from the firing position for easy access.

Rotary burners require some refractory in the combustion space to help support combustion. This refractory may be in the form of throat cones or combustion chamber liners.

Steam-Atomizing Oil Burners (Register Type)

Atomization is accomplished in this burner by the impact and expansion of steam. Oil and steam flow in separate channels through the burner gun to the burner nozzle. There, they mix before discharging through an orifice, or series of orifices, into the combustion chamber.

Combustion air, supplied by a forced-draft fan, passes through the directing vanes of the burner register, through the burner throat, and into the combustion space. The vanes give the air a spinning motion, and the burner throat directs it into the cone-shaped oil spray, where intimate mixing of air and oil takes place.

Full-load oil pressure at the burner inlet is generally some 700 to 1050 kPa, and the steam pressure is usually kept higher than the oil pressure by about 170 kPa. Load range is accomplished by varying these pressures. Some designs operate with oil pressure ranging from 1050 kPa at full load to 70 kPa at minimum load, resulting in a turndown of about 8 to 1. This wide load range makes the steam atomizing burner suited to modulating control. Some manufacturers provide dual atomizers within a single register so that one can be cleaned without dropping load.

Depending on the burner design, steam atomizing burners use from 0.1 to 0.6 kg of steam to atomize a litre of oil. This corresponds to 0.5 to 3.0% of the steam generated by the boiler. Where no steam is available for start-up, compressed air from the plant air supply may be used for atomizing. Some designs allow use of a pressure atomizing nozzle tip for start-up when neither steam nor compressed air is available.

This burner is used mainly on water-tube boilers, which generate steam at 1050 kPa or higher and at capacities above 3500 kW input.

Oils heavier than grade No. 2 must be preheated to the proper viscosity for good atomization. When properly adjusted, these burners operate well with 15% excess air (14% CO_2) at full load, without visible smoke (approximately No. 2 smoke spot number), and with only a trace of carbon monoxide in the flue gas.

Mechanical Atomizing Oil Burners (Register Type)

Mechanical atomizing, as generally used, describes a technique synonymous with pressure atomizing. Both terms designate atomization of the oil by forcing it at high pressure through a suitable stationary atomizer.

The mechanical atomizing burner has a windbox, which is a chamber into which a fan delivers combustion and excess air for distribution to the burner. The windbox has an assembly of adjustable internal air vanes called an air register. Usually, the fan is mounted separately and connected to the windbox by a duct.

Oil pressure of 600 to 6000 kPa is used, and load range is obtained by varying the pressure between these limits. The operating range or turndown for any given atomizer can be as high as 3 to 1. Because of its limited load range, this type of burner is seldom selected for new installations.

Return-Flow Mechanical Atomizing Oil Burners

This burner is a modification of a mechanical atomizing burner; atomization is accomplished by oil pressure alone. Load ranges up to 6 or 8 to 1 are obtained on a single-burner nozzle by varying the oil pressure between 700 and 7000 kPa.

The burner was developed for use in large installations such as on ships and in electric generating stations where wide load range is required and water loss from the system makes use of atomizing steam undesirable. It is also used for firing large hot-water boilers. Compressed air is too expensive for atomizing oil in large burners.

This is a register burner similar to the mechanical atomizing burner. Wide range is possible by using a return-flow nozzle, which has a swirl chamber just ahead of the orifice or sprayer plate. Good atomization is attained by maintaining a high rate of oil flow and a high pressure drop through the swirl chamber. Excess oil above the load demand is returned from the swirl chamber to the oil storage tank or to the oil pump suction. Control of burning rate is accomplished by varying the oil pressure in both the oil inlet and the oil return lines.

3.3 DUAL-FUEL GAS/OIL BURNERS

Dual-fuel, combination gas/oil burners are forced-draft burners that incorporate, in a single assembly, the features of the commercial/industrial-grade gas and oil burners described in the preceding sections. These burners have controls to ensure that the burner flame relay or programmer cycles the burner through post- and prepurge before starting again on the other fuel. Burner manufacturers for larger boilers design the special mechanical linkages needed to deliver the correct air/fuel ratios at full fire, low fire, or any intermediate rate. Smaller burners may have straight **on/off** firing. Larger burners may have low-fire starts on both fuels and use a common flame scanner. Smaller dual-fuel burners usually include pressure atomization of the oil. Air atomization systems are included in large oil burners.

Dual-fuel burners often have automatic changeover controls that respond to outdoor temperature. A special temperature control, located outdoors and electrically interlocked with the dual-fuel burner control system, senses outdoor temperature. When the outdoor temperature drops to the outdoor control set point, the control changes fuels automatically after putting the burner through post- and prepurge cycles. A manual fuel selection switch can be retained as a manual override on the automatic feature. These control systems require special design and are generally provided by the burner manufacturer.

The dual-fuel burner is fitted with a gas train and oil piping that is connected to a two-pipe oil system following the principles of the preceding sections. An oil reserve must be maintained at all times for automatic fuel changeover.

Table 2 Guide for Fuel Oil Grades Versus Firing Rate

Maximum Heat Input of Unit, kW	Volume Flow Rate, mL/s	Fuel Grade
Up to 1000	Up to 25	2
1000 to 2000	25 to 50	2, 4, 5
2000 to 4400	50 to 100	5, 6
Over 4400	Over 100	6

Boiler flue chimney connectors are equipped with special double-swing barometric draft regulators or, if required, sequential furnace draft control to operate an automatic flue damper.

Dual-fuel burners and their accessories should be installed by experienced contractors to ensure satisfactory operation.

3.4 EQUIPMENT SELECTION

Economic and practical factors (e.g., the degree of operating supervision required by the installation) generally dictate the selection of fuel oil based on the maximum heat input of the oil-burning appliance. For heating loads and where only one oil-burning appliance is operated at any given time, the relationship is as shown in Table 2 (which is only a guide). In many cases, a detailed analysis of operating parameters results in the burning of lighter grades of fuel oil at capacities far above those indicated.

Fuel Oil Storage Systems

All fuel-oil storage tanks should be constructed and installed in accordance with NFPA *Standard* 31 and with local ordinances.

Storage Capacity. Dependable and economical operation of oil-burning appliances requires ample and safe storage of fuel oil at the site. Design responsibility should include analysis of specific storage requirements as follows:

- Rate of oil consumption.
- Dependability of oil deliveries.
- Economical delivery lots. The cost of installing larger storage capacity should be balanced against the savings indicated by accommodating larger delivery lots. Truck lots and railcar lots vary with various suppliers, but the quantities are approximated as follows:

Small truck lots in metropolitan area	1900 to 7600 L
Normal truck lots	7600 to 19 000 L
Transport truck lots	19 000 to 34 000 L
Rail tanker lots	30 300 to 45 400 L

Tank Size and Location. Standard oil storage tanks range in size from 200 to 190 000 L and larger. Tanks are usually built of steel; concrete construction may be used only for heavy oil. Unenclosed tanks located in the lowest story, cellar, or basement should not exceed 2500 L capacity each, and the aggregate capacity of such tanks should not exceed 5000 L unless each 2500 L tank is insulated in an approved fireproof room having a fire resistance rating of at least 2 h.

If storage capacity at a given location exceeds about 3800 L, storage tanks should be underground and accessible for truck or rail delivery with gravity flow from the delivering carrier into storage. If the oil is to be burned in a central plant such as a boiler house, the storage tanks should be located, if possible, so that the oil burner pump (or pumps) can pump directly from storage to the burners. For year-round operation, except for storage or supply capacities below 7600 L, at least two tanks should be installed to facilitate tank inspection, cleaning, repairs, and clearing of plugged suction lines.

When the main oil storage tank is not close enough to the oil-burning appliances for the burner pumps to take suction from storage, a supply tank must be installed near the oil-burning appliances and oil must be pumped periodically from storage to the supply tank by a transport pump at the storage location. Supply tanks should be treated the same as storage tanks regarding location within buildings, tank design, etc. On large installations, it is recommended that standby pumps be installed as a protection against heat loss in case of pump failure.

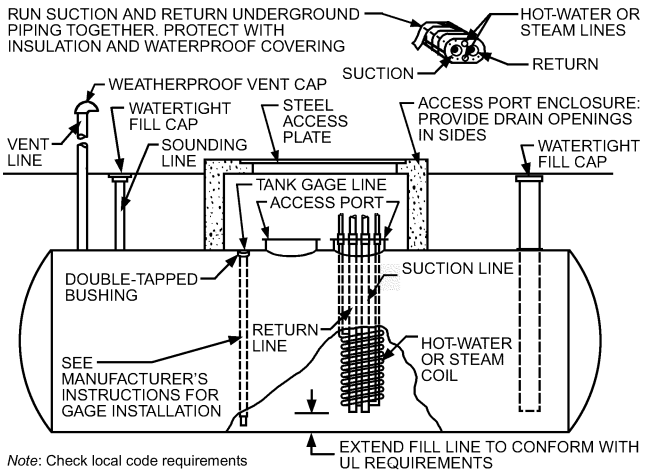


Fig. 12 Typical Oil Storage Tank (No. 6 Oil)

Because all piping connections to underground tanks must be at the top, such tanks should not be more than 3.2 m from top to bottom to avoid pump suction difficulties. (This dimension may have to be less for installations at high altitudes.) At sea level, the total suction pressure for the oil pump must not exceed 42 kPa.

Connections to Storage Tank. All piping connections for tanks over 1.0 m^3 capacity should be through the top of the tank. Figure 12 shows a typical arrangement for a cylindrical storage tank with a heating coil as required for No. 5 or 6 fuel oils. The heating coil and oil suction lines should be located near one end of the tank. The maximum allowable steam pressure in such a heating coil is 100 kPa. The heating coil is unnecessary for oils lighter than No. 5 unless a combination of high pour point and low outdoor temperature makes heating necessary.

A watertight access port with internal ladder provides access to the inside of the tank. If the tank is equipped with an internal heating coil, a second access port is required to permit withdrawal of the coil.

The fill line should be vertical and should discharge near the end of the tank away from the oil suction line. The inlet of the fill line must be outside the building and accessible to the oil delivery vehicle unless an oil transfer pump is used to fill the tank. When possible, the inlet of the fill line should be at or near grade where filling may be accomplished by gravity. For gravity filling, the fill line should be at least 50 mm in diameter for No. 2 oil and 150 mm in diameter for No. 4, 5, or 6 oils. Where filling is done by pump, the fill line for No. 4, 5, or 6 oils may be 100 mm in diameter.

An oil return line bringing recirculated oil from the burner line to the tank should discharge near the oil suction line inlet. Each storage tank should be equipped with a vent line sized and arranged in accordance with NFPA *Standard* 31.

Each storage tank must have a device for determining oil level. For tanks inside buildings, the gaging device should be designed and installed so that oil or vapor will not discharge into a building from the fuel supply system. No storage tank should be equipped with a glass gage or any gage that, if broken, would allow oil to escape from the tank. Gaging by a measuring stick is permissible for outdoor or underground tanks.

Fuel-Handling Systems

The fuel-handling system consists of the pumps, valves, and fittings for moving fuel oil from the delivery truck or car into the

storage tanks and from the storage tanks to the oil burners. Depending on the type and arrangement of the oil-burning appliances and the grade of fuel oil burned, fuel-handling systems vary from simple to quite complicated arrangements.

The simplest handling system would apply to a single burner and small storage tank for No. 2 fuel oil, similar to a residential heating installation. The storage tank is filled through a hose from the oil delivery truck, and the fuel-handling system consists of a supply pipe between the storage tank and the burner pump. Equipment should be installed on light-oil tanks to indicate visibly or audibly when the tank is full; on heavy-oil tanks, a remote-reading liquid-level gage should be installed.

Figure 13 shows a complex oil supply arrangement for two burners on one oil-burning appliance. For an appliance with a single burner, the change in piping is obvious. For a system with two or more appliances, the oil line downstream of the oil discharge strainer becomes a main supply header, and the branch supply line to each appliance includes a flowmeter, automatic control valve, etc. For light oils requiring no heating, all oil-heating equipment shown in Figure 13 would be omitted. Both a suction and a return line should be used, except for gravity flow in residential installations.

Oil pumps (steam or electrically driven) should deliver oil at the maximum rate required by the burners (this includes the maximum firing rate, the oil required for recirculating, plus a 10% margin).

The calculated suction pressure at the entrance of any burner pump should not exceed 35 kPa for installations at sea level. At higher elevations, the suction pressure should be reduced in direct proportion to the reduction in barometric pressure.

Oil temperature at the pump inlet should not exceed 50°C. Where oil burners with integral oil pumps (and oil heaters) are used and suction lift from the storage tank is within the capacity of the burner pump, each burner may take oil directly from the storage tank through an individual suction line unless No. 6 oil is used.

Where two or more tanks are used, the piping arrangement into the top of each tank should be the same as for a single tank so that any tank may be used at any time; any tank can be inspected, cleaned, or repaired while the system is in operation.

The length of suction line between storage tank and burner pumps should not exceed 30 m. If the main storage tank(s) are located more than 30 m from the pumps, a supply tank should be installed near the pumps, and a transfer pump should be installed at the storage tanks for delivery of oil to the supply tank.

Central oil distribution systems comprising a central storage facility, distribution pumps or provision for gravity delivery, distribution piping, and individual fuel meters are used for residential communities, notably mobile home parks. Provisions of NFPA *Standard* 31, Installation of Oil Burning Equipment, should be followed in installing a central oil distribution system.

Fuel Oil Preparation System

Fuel oil preparation systems consist of oil heater, oil temperature controls, strainers, and associated valves and piping required to maintain fuel oil at the temperatures necessary to control the oil viscosity, facilitate oil flow and burning, and remove suspended matter.

Preparation of fuel oil for handling and burning requires heating the oil if it is No. 5 or 6. This decreases its viscosity so it flows properly through the oil system piping and can be atomized by the oil burner. No. 4 oil occasionally requires heating to facilitate burning. No. 2 oil requires heating only under unusual conditions.

For handling residual oil from the delivering carrier into storage tanks, the viscosity should be about 156 mm^2/s. For satisfactory pumping, viscosity of oil surrounding the inlet of the suction pipe must be 444 mm^2/s or lower; for oil with a high pour point, the temperature of the entire oil content of the tank must be above the pour point.

Storage tank heaters are usually made of pipe coils or grids using steam or hot water at or less than 100 kPa as the heating medium. Electric heaters are sometimes used. For control of viscosity for pumping, the heated oil surrounds the oil suction line inlet. For heating oils with high pour points, the heater should extend the entire

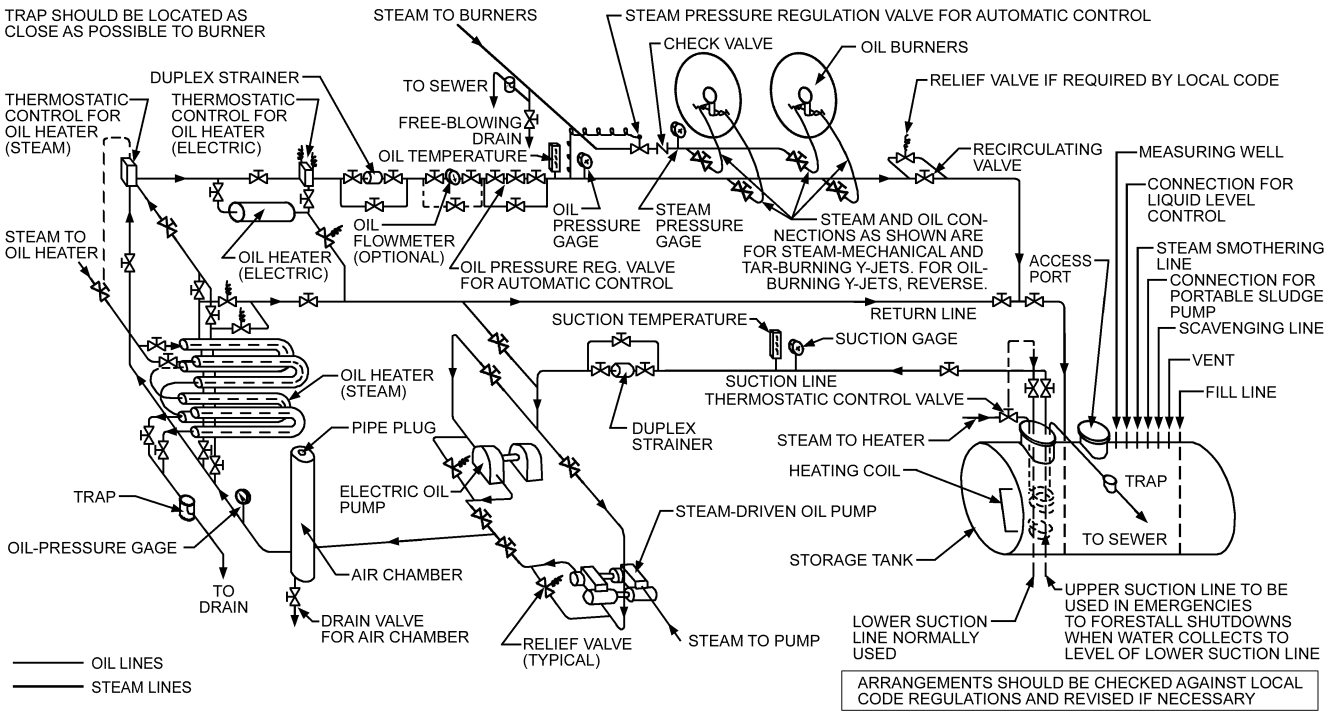


Fig. 13 Industrial Burner Auxiliary Equipment

length of the tank. All heaters have suitable thermostatic controls. In some cases, storage tanks may be heated satisfactorily by returning or recirculating some of the oil to the tank after it has passed through heaters located between the oil pump and oil burner.

Heaters to regulate viscosity at the burners are installed between the oil pumps and the burners. When required for small packaged burners, the heaters are either assembled integrally with the individual burners or mounted separately. The heat source may be electricity, steam, or hot water. For larger installations, the heater is mounted separately and is often arranged in combination with central oil pumps, forming a central oil pumping and heating set. The separate or central oil pumping and heating set is recommended for installations that burn heavy oils, have a periodic load demand, and require continuous circulation of hot oil during down periods.

Another system of oil heating to maintain pumping viscosity that is occasionally used for small- or medium-sized installations consists of an electrically heated section of oil piping. Low-voltage current is passed through the pipe section, which is isolated by nonconducting flanges.

The oil-heating capacity for any given installation should be approximately 10% greater than the maximum oil flow. Maximum oil flow is the maximum oil-burning rate plus the rate of oil recirculation.

Controls for oil heaters must be dependable to ensure proper oil atomization and avoid overheating of oil, which results in coke deposits inside the heaters. In steam or electric heating, include an interlock with a solenoid valve or switch to shut off the steam or electricity. When the oil pump is not operating, the oil in the heater can become overheated and deposit carbon. Overheating also can be a problem with oil heaters using high-temperature hot water. Provisions must be made to avoid overheating the oil when the oil pump is not operating.

Oil heaters with low- or medium-temperature hot water are not generally subject to coke deposits. Where steam or hot water is used in oil heaters located after the oil pumps, the pressure of the steam or water in the heaters is usually lower than the oil pressure. Consequently, heater leakage between oil and steam causes oil to flow into the water or condensing steam. To prevent oil from entering the boilers, discard the condensed steam or the water from such heaters from the system, or provide special equipment for oil removal.

Hot-water oil heaters of double-tube-and-shell construction with inert heat transfer oil and a sight glass between the tubes are available. With this type of heater, oil leaks through an oil-side tube appear in the sight glass, and repairs can be made to the oil-side tube before a water-side tube leaks.

This discussion of oil-burning equipment also applies to oil-fired boilers and furnaces (see Chapters 32 and 33).

4. SOLID-FUEL-BURNING APPLIANCES

A mechanical stoker is a device that feeds a solid fuel into a combustion chamber. It supplies air for burning the fuel under automatic control and, in some cases, incorporates automatic ash and refuse removal.

4.1 CAPACITY CLASSIFICATION OF STOKERS

Stokers are classified according to their coal-feeding rates. Although some residential applications still use stokers, their main application is in commercial and industrial areas. The U.S. Department of Commerce, in cooperation with the Stoker Manufacturers Association, use the following classification:

Class 1: Capacity less than 27 kg of coal per hour
Class 2: Capacity 27 to less than 45 kg of coal per hour
Class 3: Capacity 45 to less than 136 kg of coal per hour
Class 4: Capacity 136 to less than 544 kg of coal per hour
Class 5: Capacity 544 kg of coal per hour and over

Class 1 stokers are used primarily for residential heating and are designed for quiet, automatic operation. These stokers are usually underfeed types and are similar to those shown in Figure 14, except that they are usually screw-feed. Class 1 stokers feed coal to the furnace intermittently, in accordance with temperature or pressure demands. A special control is needed to ensure stoker operation to maintain a fire during periods when no heat is required.

Class 2 and 3 stokers are usually of the screw-feed type, without auxiliary plungers or other means of distributing the coal. They are used extensively for heating plants in apartment buildings, hotels, and industrial plants. They are of the underfeed type and are available in both the hopper and bin-feed type. These stokers are also built in a plunger-feed type with an electric motor, steam, or hydraulic cylinder coal-feed drive.

Class 2 and 3 stokers are available for burning all types of anthracite, bituminous, and lignite coals. The tuyere and retort design varies according to the fuel and load conditions. Stationary grates are used on bituminous models, and clinkers formed from the ash accumulate on the grates surrounding the retort.

Class 2 and 3 anthracite stokers are equipped with moving grates that discharge ash into a pit below the grate. This ash pit may be located on one side or both sides of the grate and, in some installations, is big enough to hold the ash for several weeks of operation.

Class 4 stokers vary in details of design, and several methods of feeding coal are practiced. Underfeed stokers are widely used, although overfeed types are used in the larger sizes. Bin-feed and hopper models are available in underfeed and overfeed types.

Class 5 stokers are spreader, underfeed, chain or traveling grate, and vibrating grate. Various subcategories reflect the type of grate and method of ash discharge.

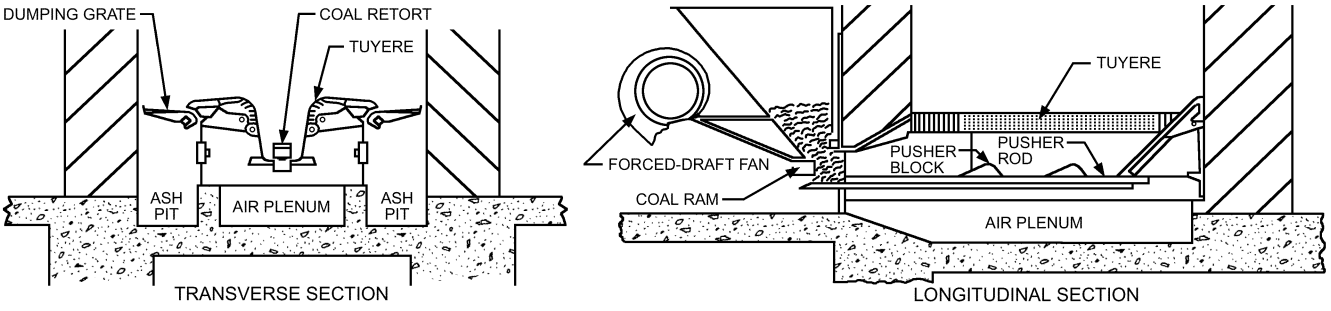


Fig. 14 Horizontal Underfeed Stoker with Single Retort

Table 3 Characteristics of Various Types of Stokers (Class 5)

Stoker Type and Subclass	Typical Capacity Range, kg/s	Maximum Burning Rate, kW/m²	Characteristics
Spreader			Capable of burning a wide range of coals; best to follow fluctuating loads; high fly ash carryover; low-load smoke
Stationary and dumping grate	2.5 to 10	1400	
Traveling grate	13 to 50	2400	
Vibrating grate	2.5 to 13	1300	
Underfeed	2.5 to 4	1300	Capable of burning caking coals and a wide range of coals (including anthracite); high maintenance; low fly ash carryover; suitable for continuous-load operation
Single- or double-retort			
Multiple-retort	4 to 63	1900	
Chain grate and *traveling grate*	2.5 to 13	1600	Low maintenance; low fly ash carryover; capable of burning a wide variety of weakly caking coals; smokeless operation over entire range
Vibrating grate	0.2 to 19	1300	Characteristics similar to chain and traveling grate stokers, except that these stokers have no difficulty in burning strongly caking coals

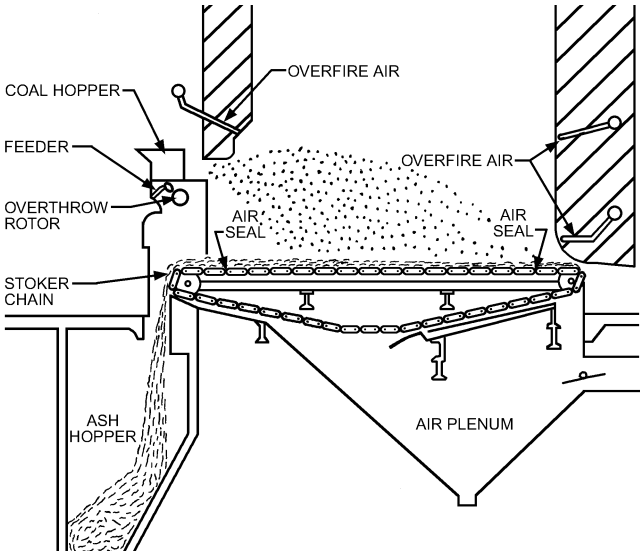


Fig. 15 Spreader Stoker, Traveling Grate Type

4.2 STOKER TYPES BY FUEL-FEED METHODS

Class 5 stokers are classified according to the method of feeding fuel to the furnace: (1) spreader, (2) underfeed, (3) chain or traveling grate, and (4) vibrating grate. The type of stoker used in a given installation depends on the general system design, capacity required, and type of fuel burned. In general, the spreader stoker is the most widely used in the capacity range of 9.5 to 50 kg/s because it responds quickly to load changes and can burn a wide variety of coals. Underfeed stokers are mainly used with small industrial boilers of less than 3.8 kg/s. In the intermediate range, the large underfeed stokers, as well as the chain and traveling grate stokers, are being displaced by spreader and vibrating grate stokers. Table 3 summarizes the major features of the different stokers.

Spreader Stokers

Spreader stokers use a combination of suspension burning and grate burning. As shown in Figure 15, coal is continually projected into the furnace above an ignited fuel bed. The coal fines are partially burned in suspension. Large particles fall to the grate and are burned in a thin, fast-burning fuel bed. Because this firing method provides extreme responsiveness to load fluctuations and because ignition is almost instantaneous on increased firing rate, the spreader stoker is favored over other stokers in many industrial applications.

The spreader stoker is designed to burn about 50% of the fuel in suspension. Thus, it generates much higher particulate loadings than other types of stokers and requires dust collectors to trap particulate material in the flue gas before discharge to the stack. To minimize carbon loss, fly carbon reinjection systems are sometimes used to return particles into the furnace for complete burnout. Because this process increases furnace dust emissions, it can be used only with highly efficient dust collectors.

Grates for spreader stokers may be of several types. All grates are designed with high airflow resistance to avoid formation of blowholes through the thin fuel bed. Early designs were simple stationary grates from which ash was removed manually. Later designs allowed intermittent dumping of the grate either manually or by a power cylinder. Both types of dumping grates are frequently used for small and medium-sized boilers (see Table 3). Also, both types are sectionalized, and there is a separate undergrate air chamber for each grate section and a grate section for each spreader stoker. Consequently, both the air supply and the fuel supply to one section can be temporarily discontinued for cleaning and maintenance without affecting operation of other sections of the stoker.

For high-efficiency operation, a continuous ash-discharging grate, such as the traveling grate, is necessary. Introduction of the spreader stoker with the traveling grate increased burning rates by about 70% over the stationary and dumping grate types. Although both reciprocating and vibrating continuous ash discharge grates have been developed, the traveling grate stoker is preferred because of its higher burning rates.

Fuels and Fuel Bed. All spreader stokers (particularly those with traveling grates) can use fuels with a wide range of burning characteristics, including caking tendencies, because the rapid surface heating of the coal in suspension destroys the caking tendency. High-moisture, free-burning bituminous and lignite coals are commonly burned; coke breeze can be burned in mixture with a high-volatile coal. However, anthracite, because of its low volatile content, is not a suitable fuel for spreader stoker firing. Ideally, the fuel bed of a coal-fired spreader stoker is 50 to 100 mm thick.

Burning Rates. The maximum heat release rates range from 1250 kW/m² (a coal consumption of approximately 5 g/s) on stationary, dumping, and vibrating grate designs to 2400 kW/m² on traveling grate spreader stokers. Higher heat release rates are practical with some waste fuels in which a greater portion of fuel can be burned in suspension than is possible with coal.

Underfeed Stokers

Underfeed stokers introduce raw coal into a retort beneath the burning fuel bed. They are classified as horizontal or gravity feed. In the horizontal type, coal travels within the furnace in a retort parallel with the floor; in the gravity-feed type, the retort is inclined by 25°. Most horizontal-feed stokers are designed with single or double

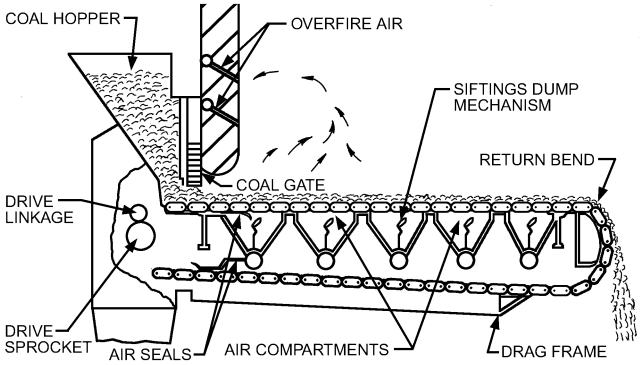


Fig. 16 Chain Grate Stoker

retorts (and, rarely, triple retorts), whereas gravity-feed stokers are designed with multiple retorts.

In the horizontal stoker (see Figure 14), coal is fed to the retort by a screw (for smaller stokers) or a ram (for larger stokers). Once the retort is filled, the coal is forced upward and spills over the retort to form and feed the fuel bed. Air is supplied through tuyeres at each side of the retort and through air ports in the side grates. Over-fire air provides additional combustion air to the flame zone directly above the bed to prevent smoking, especially at low loads.

Gravity-feed stokers are similar in operating principle. These stokers consist of sloping multiple retorts and have rear ash discharge. Coal is fed into each retort, where it is moved slowly to the rear while simultaneously being forced upward over the retorts.

Fuels and Fuel Bed. Either type of underfeed stoker can burn a wide range of coal, although the horizontal type is better suited for free-burning bituminous coal. These stokers can burn caking coal, if there is not an excess amount of fines. The ash-softening temperature is an important factor in selecting coals because the possibility of excessive clinkering increases at lower ash-softening temperatures. Because combustion occurs in the fuel bed, underfeed stokers respond slowly to load change. Fuel-bed thickness is extremely nonuniform, ranging from 200 to over 600 mm. The fuel bed often contains large fissures separating masses of coke.

Burning Rates. Single-retort or double-retort horizontal stokers are generally used to service boilers with capacities up to 3.8 kg/s. These stokers are designed for heat release rates of 1300 kW/m^2.

Chain and Traveling Grate Stokers

Figure 16 shows a typical chain or traveling grate stoker. These stokers are often used interchangeably because they are fundamentally the same, except for grate construction. The essential difference is that the links of chain grate stokers are assembled so that they move with a scissors-like action at the return bend of the stoker, whereas in most traveling grates there is no relative movement between adjacent grate sections. Accordingly, the chain grate is more suitable for handling coal with clinkering ash characteristics than is the traveling grate stoker.

Operation of the two types is similar. Coal, fed from a hopper onto the moving grate, enters the furnace after passing under an adjustable gate that regulates the thickness of the fuel bed. The layer of coal on the grate entering the furnace is heated by radiation from the furnace gases or from a hot refractory arch. As volatile matter is driven off by this rapid radiative heating, ignition occurs. The fuel continues to burn as it moves along the fuel bed, and the layer becomes progressively thinner. At the far end of the grate, where the coal completes combustion, ash is discharged into the pit as the grates pass downward over a return bend.

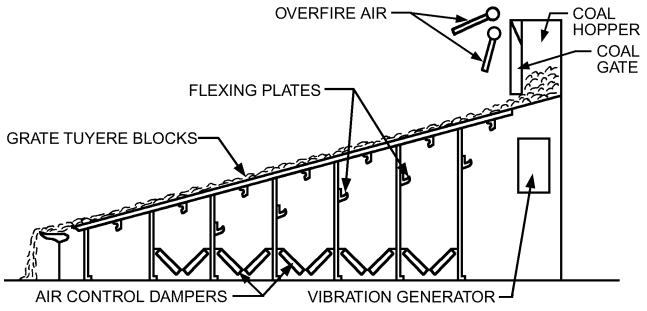


Fig. 17 Vibrating Grate Stoker

Often, furnace arches (front and/or rear) are included with these stokers to improve combustion by reflecting heat to the fuel bed. The front arch also serves as a bluff body, mixing rich streams of volatile gases with air to reduce unburned hydrocarbons. A chain grate stoker with overfire air jets eliminates the need for a front arch for burning volatiles. As shown in Figure 17, the stoker was zoned, or sectionalized, and equipped with individual zone dampers to control the pressure and quantity of air delivered to the various sections.

Fuels and Fuel Bed. The chain grate and traveling grate stokers can burn a variety of fuels (e.g., peat, lignite, subbituminous coal, free-burning bituminous coal, anthracite coal, coke), as long as the fuel is sized properly. However, strongly caking bituminous coals have a tendency to mat and prevent proper air distribution to the fuel bed. Also, a bed of strongly caking coal may not be responsive to rapidly changing loads. Fuel bed thickness varies with the type and size of the coal burned. For bituminous coal, a 125 to 180 mm bed is common; for small-sized anthracite, the fuel bed is reduced to 75 to 125 mm.

Burning Rates. Chain and traveling grate stokers are offered for a maximum continuous burning rate of 1100 to 1600 kW/m^2, depending on the type of fuel and its ash and moisture content.

Vibrating Grate Stokers

The vibrating grate stoker, as shown in Figure 17, is similar to the chain grate stoker in that both are overfeed, mass-burning, continuous ash discharge stokers. However, in the vibrating stoker, the sloping grate is supported on equally spaced vertical plates that oscillate back and forth in a rectilinear direction, causing the fuel to move from the hopper through an adjustable gate into the active combustion zone. Air is supplied to the stoker through laterally exposed areas beneath the stoker formed by the individual flexing of the grate support plates. Ash is automatically discharged into a shallow or basement ash pit. The grates are water cooled and are connected to the boiler circulating system.

The rates of coal feed and fuel bed movement are determined by the frequency and duration of the vibrating cycles and regulated by automatic combustion controls that proportion the air supply to optimize heat release rates. Typically, the grate is vibrated about every 90 s for durations of 2 to 3 s, but this depends on the type of coal and boiler operation. The vibrating grate stoker is increasingly popular because of its simplicity, inherently low fly ash carryover, low maintenance, wide turndown (10 to 1), and adaptability to multiple-fuel firing.

Fuels and Fuel Bed. The water-cooled vibrating grate stoker is suitable for burning a wide range of bituminous and lignite coals. The gentle agitation and compaction of the vibratory actions allow coal having a high free-swelling index to be burned and a uniform fuel bed without blowholes and thin spots to be maintained. The uniformity of air distribution and fuel bed conditions produce both good response to load swings and smokeless operation over the

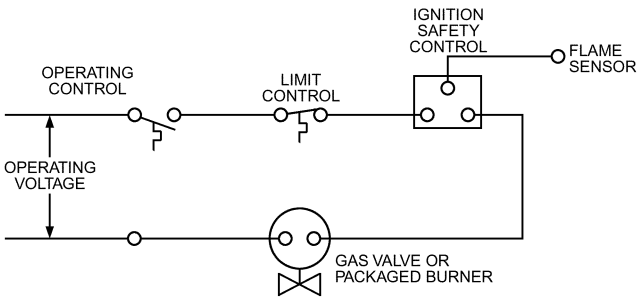


Fig. 18 Basic Control Circuit for Fuel-Burning Appliance

entire load range. Fly ash emission is probably greater than from the traveling grate because of the slight intermittent agitation of the fuel bed. The fuel bed is similar to that of a traveling grate stoker.

Burning Rates. Burning rates of vibrating grate stokers vary with the type of fuel used. In general, however, the maximum heat release rate should not exceed 1300 kW/m^2 (a coal use of approximately 5 g/s) to minimize fly ash carryover.

5. CONTROLS

This section covers controls required for automatic fuel-burning systems. Chapter 7 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* addresses basic automatic control.

Automatic fuel-burning appliances require control systems that supervise combustion and take proper corrective action in the event of a failure in the appliance or related installation equipment. Requirements are similar for gas, oil, and solid fuel (stoker) burners.

Controls can be classified as safety or operating. **Safety controls** monitor potentially hazardous operating conditions such as ignition, combustion, temperature, and pressure, and function as required to ensure safe operation. **Operating controls** handle appliance operation at the required input rate when heat is required.

Figure 18 illustrates the basic elements of a control system for a fuel-fired appliance. In this diagram, the limit control and the ignition safety control, including its sensor, are safety controls.

5.1 SAFETY CONTROLS AND INTERLOCKS

Safety controls protect against hazards related to the combustion process. Personnel and material near the appliance must be protected against explosion, fire, or excessive temperature. Common safety control functions include the following:

- Ignition and flame monitoring
  - Ignition proving (e.g., gas pilot thermocouple, flame rectification)
  - Proof of flame
- Draft proof (e.g., sail switch, pressure switch)
- Limit controls
  - Excessive temperature of heated medium (e.g., air or water)
  - Excessive pressure of heated medium (e.g., steam or hot water)
  - Low water level in steam or hot-water boilers
  - Low fuel-oil pressure
  - Low or excessive fuel-oil temperature when burning heavy oils
  - Low atomizing air pressure or atomizing steam pressure
  - Low fuel-gas pressure (e.g., empty propane tank)
- Flue gas spillage switch
- Flame rollout detection
- Carbon monoxide sensors
- Similar devices to prevent hazards from abnormal conditions
- Safety-related mechanical malfunction controls (e.g., open furnace blower door, burner out of position or rotary cup burner motor failure)
- Field interlocks having safety function

Ignition and Flame Monitoring

Failure to ignite fuel or failure of an established flame can cause explosion, if unburned fuel is subsequently provided with an ignition source. Ignition and flame safeguard controls, properly applied and used, prevent these occurrences. Some ignition controls monitor existence of an ignition source such as a pilot burner, allowing introduction and continued flow of fuel only when the ignition source is proven. Others use devices that ignite the main flame directly, in conjunction with high-speed flame detection capabilities and rapid shutdown of the fuel supply, if ignition is not immediate or if the flame is lost. Ignition controls often include programming features that govern the entire sequence of operation when a burner is started, operated, and stopped.

In residential gas-fired appliances, burners are usually ignited by a small standing gas pilot flame, by an intermittent pilot system, or by a direct ignition system. Standing pilot systems prove existence of the ignition source by sensing its heat with a thermocouple. In intermittent pilot systems, a spark or hot surface igniter lights the pilot burner when there is a call for heat, thus saving pilot burner fuel when no heat is needed. Flame rectification (the ability of a flame to change an alternating current to direct current) is commonly used to prove the existence of the pilot flame (in intermittent pilot systems) or main burner flame (in direct-ignition systems). In direct-ignition systems, a spark or hot surface device ignites the main burner directly, eliminating the need for a pilot burner. If flame is not immediately established during ignition or if an established flame is lost, the gas supply system is quickly shut off. Flame rollout (flame escaping the appliance combustion chamber) protection detects flame in appliance combustion air inlet areas by sensing high temperatures and shuts off the fuel supply.

Most residential oil-burners use high-energy sparking for ignition. Sparking may be continuous (present for the entire duration of burner operation) or intermittent (present only long enough to establish presence of the flame). Most residential oil burners use an oil primary control that operates the burner motor and ignition spark transformer in conjunction with a flame detector. Flame proof is typically achieved by sensing visible or ultraviolet light emitted by the flame. A cadmium cell is used to detect visible light: its resistance changes when exposed to light from a burner flame, and that change is interpreted and acted upon by the primary control.

Commercial appliances with high fuel input rates normally use some form of a proven ignition source, often a standing or intermittent pilot burner, which itself may be quite large. North American safety standards do not allow use of direct-ignition systems for appliances with input greater than 117 kW. Standing pilots or a proved igniter system must be used. The latter may closely resemble the direct-ignition system, except that the existence of the ignition source must be proven before fuel gas is allowed to flow to the main burner. As in the direct-ignition system, main burner gas flow is shut down if flame is not established quickly or if it goes out after ignition. Flame proving in large appliances is typically by flame rectification or ultraviolet light sensing.

Draft Proving

Fuel-burning appliances often include forced- or induced-draft blowers to move combustion air and combustion products through the appliance and venting systems. Sometimes blowers are applied outside the appliance in the venting system. Draft-proving controls supervise proper operation of these components to allow gas flow, ignition, and combustion only if appliance draft is adequate, typically using pressure and/or flow sensors to verify sufficient draft.

Limit Controls

In a warm-air furnace or space heater, excessive air temperature must be prevented. In a hot-water boiler, water temperature and pressure must not exceed the ratings of external piping and terminal equipment. Steam pressure must not exceed ratings of pressure vessels and steam system equipment. Fuel oil must be provided at pressures and temperatures that allow proper operation of oil burners. These requirements and restrictions are the focus of limit controls required by installation codes and appliance standards, and applied by appliance manufacturers and field installers. Design and principle of operation vary greatly, but in all cases limit controls must provide reliable detection of a fault and shut down the fuel-burning appliance.

Other Safety Controls

Requirements for safety devices are a function of the particular appliance and installation circumstances, and must be considered in that context. Appliances listed or design-certified as complying with recognized safety standards generally have appropriate safety devices as required by those standards. Building codes typically require appliances to be listed or design-certified by recognized testing laboratories, and that appliances not listed or design-certified comply with requirements within the code. Field circumstances may impose a need for control interlocks that relate to safety. Mechanical-draft venting systems, for example, must be proven to be in operation before an appliance ignition attempt and during burner operation. An appropriate field-installed interlock to prove mechanical-draft venting system operation before an ignition attempt would be considered a safety control.

Prescriptive Requirements for Safety Controls

Industrial safety codes and insurers often require that fuel-fired appliances be provided with specific components and construction features related to safety. Codes and requirements such as ASME *Standard* CSD-1 for boilers or those of insurance organizations may apply. Prescriptive governmental requirements may also apply to some types of installations. Often, requirements are based on the type of appliance, its capacity or size, or the intended use, such as type of building occupancy.

Reliability of Safety Controls

Devices suitable for use as safety controls must meet special quality and reliability requirements. Electrical contacts, for example, must be able to switch the intended load through high cycle counts under extreme environmental conditions. Products designed for safety control application are invariably listed, or design-certified as complying with recognized standards that impose a wide range of construction and testing requirements. The degree of reliability of safety controls must be extremely high, and normally far exceeds that required of operating controls to meet appliance safety standards.

5.2 OPERATING CONTROLS

Operating controls start and stop burner operation in response to demands of the application load, and often incorporate capabilities for load matching and other application-related features. In contrast to safety controls, their purpose is to satisfy the application's fundamental purpose (e.g., warm air, hot water, steam pressure). Related functions may involve operating ancillary components of the appliance or system, such as blowers or pumps, which must operate at the appropriate speed.

Load matching is the most significant differentiating feature of operating controls. The major categories are on/off, staged, and modulated control. Fuel input rate varies for the latter two modes, but combustion airflow rate may also be controlled.

An **on/off control** starts and stops the flow of fuel to the burner to satisfy heat demand. An appliance with on/off control can operate only at its rated input regardless of the rate at which combustion heat may be needed. In a typical system, demand is sensed by a temperature or pressure sensor. When the temperature or pressure falls to an *on* set point, the control initiates combustion, which proceeds until the temperature or pressure increases to an *off* set point. The difference between the *off* and *on* values is called the **differential**. On/off control is satisfactory for systems with high thermal inertia (i.e., those in which heat input does not rapidly change the controlled temperature or pressure).

A **staged control** operates an appliance at multiple fixed input rates in response to heat demand. The input rates are determined by burner system hardware and settings. A residential gas-fired appliance, for example, may include a gas pressure regulator capable of providing high and low gas pressures to the gas orifice(s). Applying electrical power to a solenoid associated with the pressure regulator enables a second orifice pressure and thus a second gas input rate. In large appliances such as commercial boilers, staging is often accomplished with multiple burner assemblies, operated singly or together as necessary to match the load. As in on/off control, combustion initiation and changes between high and low input rates are in response to demand, as determined by the sensor and control logic.

Staged control logic is sometimes provided within an appliance control to enhance load response of the appliance. For example, a heating appliance control can provide staged burner operation without a staged room thermostat by beginning burner operation on burner stage 1 when a single-stage thermostat calls for heat. If burner stage 1 does not satisfy the thermostat within a specified time period, the appliance control turns on burner stage 2 until the thermostat is satisfied, at which time the burner is completely shut off until the thermostat's next call for heat.

Figure 19 illustrates the characteristics of a three-stage control system that provides heat in response to a temperature sensor and is required to maintain temperature at a set point t_S. If the controlled temperature is above t_S, no heat is provided. When the temperature drops to t_{1On}, the first-stage burner is operated; if the temperature then rises back to t_S, the burner is turned off. If the first stage is inadequate, the temperature continues to fall; when it reaches t_{2On}, the second stage is operated. A third stage is available if the second stage is not adequate, operating when the temperature falls to its *on* temperature t_{3On}. Successful handling of the load results in raising of the controlled temperature and stepped sequential reduction of the heat input as the

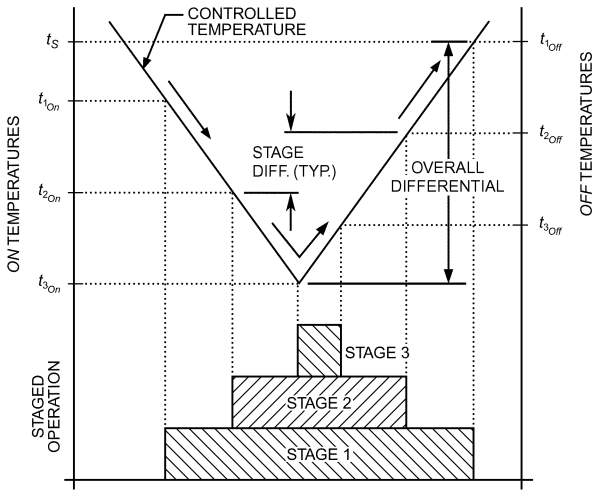


Fig. 19 Control Characteristics of Three-Stage System

off temperatures t_{3Off}, t_{2Off}, and t_{1Off} (= t_S) are reached. The individual stages operate subject to a **stage differential**, which is the difference between the temperature at which a stage is shut off and the (lower) temperature at which it is again turned on. Interstage differential and overall differential, as shown in Figure 19, are analogous. The *on* and *off* temperatures may or may not overlap, depending on the relative size of the stage differentials. In sophisticated electronic controls, the differential settings are adjustable to meet the particular requirements of the application.

Staged control logic often includes features that enhance load response or appliance operation. As shown in Figure 19, load matching might be best if the control initiates the lowest input rate on a call for heat and proceeds to higher inputs only if the demand cannot be met at lower rates. Appliance or application characteristics may dictate other approaches. For example, if appliance ignition is most reliable at high input rate, a staged control might require that ignition begin at a high input rate with an immediate reduction to a lower input rate to meet the actual heat demand.

Combustion airflow may or may not be staged. If not, operation at lower input rates, particularly in appliances with fan-assisted combustion, results in lean operation (a high percentage of excess air). There may be little effect, but in general, heat transfer efficiency suffers if the combustion air-to-fuel ratio (A/F) is not maintained at an optimum level on each stage.

A **modulating control** regulates input rate to follow load demands more closely than on/off or staged controls. Fuel input rate may be varied by throttling (mechanical restriction of flow by a valve) or by pressure regulation to control injector (orifice) pressure. Demand is often indicated by a temperature or pressure sensor, and the input rate increases as the temperature or pressure falls from set point values. In large fuel-oil appliances, a fuel oil control valve and burner damper respond over a range of positions within the operating range of the burner.

Air/fuel proportioning controls are a variation of modulating controls in which the proper ratio of air to fuel is maintained throughout the burner's fuel input range. In response to the need for heat, both fuel input rate and combustion airflow rate are modulated, maintaining an optimal air/fuel ratio to maximize efficiency. The controls may change blower speed or (particularly in large commercial appliances) link air dampers to fuel input rate control.

Tracking controls are proportioning controls that maintain the proper air/fuel ratio by applying basic Bernoulli-equation fluid flow behavior. Gas-fired appliances are especially suitable for this approach. As combustion air or gas flow rate changes, such as through metering orifices or venturis, pressure changes in proportion to the square of the air or gas velocity. The pressure differential created by forcing air through a venturi, for example, can be used to regulate gas flow through an orifice. When the relationship is established, a change of airflow rate results in a pressure differential change that causes a proportional (tracking) change in gas flow rate. In one approach, airflow rate is varied according to heating demand by changing blower speed or adjusting a damper position, and gas flow rate tracks the change. Variations may use intermediate ratio controllers. Other systems control gas input rate, and combustion air rate tracks. In the ideal case, the air-to-fuel ratio remains constant at all input rates, and efficiency increases substantially when firing rate is reduced.

Combustion quality is monitored and controlled in some large installations to ensure efficient operation or satisfactory emission characteristics. Air or fuel can be controlled in response to devices that sense concentrations of various combustion product constituents. Butcher (1990) used the measured intensity of light emitted from flames of fixed-input oil burners to judge basic flame quality. Flame steady-state intensity is compared to a predetermined flame intensity set point. Deviation of flame intensity beyond an optimum intensity range indicates poor flame quality.

Operating controls often provide functions not directly related to combustion. These **appliance controls** include things such as operating air-circulating blowers or pumps according to the fuel combustion system's needs. A blower or pump can be operated in response to a temperature or pressure sensor or according to a time protocol imposed with electronic or digital capabilities. Additional algorithms in the appliance control can further enhance appliance operation.

Integrated and Programmed Controls

Integrated Controls. Many appliance controls combine safety and operating functions into electronic microprocessors with various sensors and electromechanical devices to handle most of the control functions necessary to operate fuel-burning appliances. Figure 20 illustrates an integrated control approach typical of residential forced-air furnaces or boilers with fan-assisted combustion and a limit control. Other safety devices, such as a flame roll-out switch, typically are present. For a forced-air furnace, the remote thermostat would be a wall thermostat. For a hot-water boiler, the operating control might be a wall thermostat, possibly with a second sensor to control boiler water temperature. Ignition and flame safety algorithms are provided in the microprocessor-based control. The ignition device and flame sensor are connected to the control. Note that the control operates both the circulating blower or pump and a combustion blower. Both are controlled in accordance with an appropriate sequence of operation. A draft-proving device is connected to the control to confirm operation of the combustion blower prior to igniter operation and opening of the gas valve, and during subsequent burner operation. Typically, light-emitting diodes (LEDs) are provided on the control to indicate operating status and to facilitate diagnosis of operating problems.

Programmed controls for ignition and flame safeguard have been used in large fuel-fired appliances for many years. More recently, programming has been applied in integrated controls for smaller appliances. These controls handle not only the ignition sequence, but also operating functions, and provide status and diagnostic information. Accomplishing those functions with separate components would be difficult and clumsy.

When power is supplied, an integrated control conducts a self-check to ensure that the appliance and control system are in safe working order, and then typically indicates readiness by flashing one or more LEDs. The self-check may include verifying that the flame-proving device does not indicate flame before the ignition sequence has started and the draft-proving device does not indicate draft before the combustion blower has started. Self-checking for safe conditions may continue during burner operation and during

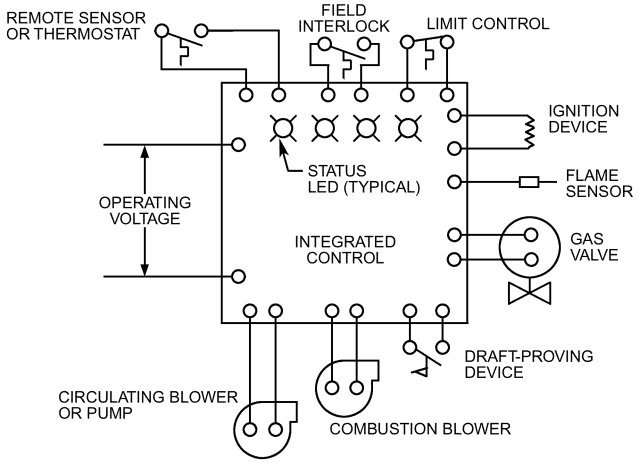


Fig. 20 Integrated Control System for Gas-Fired Appliance

standby after the thermostat is satisfied. If unacceptable operation is detected, the control will take corrective action or attempt safe shutoff of the appliance. On a call for heat, an operating sequence typically proceeds as follows:

1. The call for heat is indicated by an assigned LED flashing sequence.
2. The combustion blower starts and its operation is verified by the draft-proving device.
3. When the combustion blower has run long enough to purge the combustion chamber of residual fuel and combustion products (i.e., flush it with four air changes), the ignition device energizes.
4. The control allows enough time for the ignition device to become operative. In some applications, operation is verified electronically.
5. The gas valve opens.
6. Flame detection checks for main burner ignition. If flame presence is not proven within a very short predetermined time, or if continuous proof of flame fails at any time while the gas valve is open, the gas valve closes. Programming typically requires rapid detection of flame failure, and gas shutoff in accordance with safety standards.
7. If flame presence is detected, the air circulating blower or hot-water pump is started. Depending on the application, blower or pump operation could start with burner operation or after a time delay.
8. When the call for heat is satisfied, the gas valve closes to extinguish the burner flame.
9. The combustion blower operates for a short period to flush the combustion chamber with air (post purge).
10. The circulating blower or pump stops, usually after an application-specific delay.
11. The status LED(s) return to the standby mode.

This sequence can be varied as necessary to accommodate the requirements of specific appliances and applications. For example, staged or modulated operation may be included.

Status LEDs are turned on and off in particular patterns to display coded diagnostic information for many different normal and abnormal conditions (e.g., failure to prove draft, failure to detect flame, overtemperature). Appliance standards and installation codes require that appliance controls lock out operation of the burner system in response to certain failure conditions, when manual intervention by a qualified service agency is necessary.

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CHAPTER 32

BOILERS

Classifications 32.1
Selection Parameters 32.5
Efficiency: Input and Output Ratings 32.6
Performance Codes and Standards 32.6
Sizing 32.6
Burner Types 32.7
Boiler Controls 32.7
Flame Safeguard Controls 32.8

BOILERS are pressure vessels designed to transfer heat (produced by combustion) to a fluid. The definition has been expanded to include transfer of heat from electrical resistance elements to the fluid or by direct action of electrodes on the fluid. In most boilers, the fluid is usually water in the form of liquid or steam. If the fluid being heated is air, the heat exchange device is called a furnace, not a boiler. The firebox, or combustion chamber, of some boilers is also called a furnace.

Excluding special and unusual fluids, materials, and methods, a boiler is a cast-iron, carbon or stainless steel, aluminum, or copper pressure vessel heat exchanger designed to (1) burn fossil fuels (or use electric current) and (2) transfer the released heat to water (in water boilers) or to water and steam (in steam boilers). Boiler heating surface is the area of fluid-backed surface exposed to the products of combustion, or the fire-side surface. Various manufacturers define allowable heat transfer rates in terms of heating surface based on their specific boiler design and material limitations. Boiler designs provide for connections to a piping system, which delivers heated fluid to the point of use and returns the cooled fluid to the boiler.

Chapters 6, 11, 12, 13, and 15 cover applications of heating boilers. Chapter 7 discusses cogeneration, which may require boilers.

1. CLASSIFICATIONS

Boilers may be grouped into classes based on working pressure and temperature, fuel used, material of construction, type of draft (natural or mechanical), and whether they are condensing or noncondensing. They may also be classified according to shape and size, application (e.g., heating, process), and state of output medium (steam or water). Boiler classifications are important to the specifying engineer because they affect performance, first cost, and space requirements. Excluding designed-to-order boilers, significant class descriptions are given in boiler catalogs or are available from the boiler manufacturer. The following basic classifications may be helpful.

Working Pressure and Temperature

With few exceptions, boilers are constructed to meet ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*, Section IV (SCIV), Rules for Construction of Heating Boilers (low-pressure boilers), or Section I (SCI), Rules for Construction of Power Boilers (high-pressure boilers).

Low-pressure boilers are constructed for maximum working pressures of 103 kPa (gage) steam and up to 1100 kPa (gage) hot water. Hot-water boilers are limited to 120°C operating temperature. Operating and safety controls and relief valves, which limit temperature and pressure, are ancillary devices required to protect the boiler and prevent operation beyond design limits.

High-pressure boilers are designed to operate above 103 kPa (gage) steam, or above 1100 kPa (gage) and/or 120°C for water boilers. Similarly, operating and safety controls and relief valves are required.

Steam boilers are generally available in standard sizes from 17 kW to 30 MW, many of which are used for space heating applications in both new and existing systems. On larger installations, they may also provide steam for auxiliary uses, such as hot water heat exchangers, absorption cooling, laundry, and sterilizers. In addition, many steam boilers provide steam at various temperatures and pressures for a wide variety of industrial processes.

Water boilers are generally available in standard sizes from 10 kW to over 30 MW, many of which are in the low-pressure class and are used primarily for space heating applications in both new and existing systems. Some water boilers may be equipped with either internal or external heat exchangers for domestic water service.

Every steam or water boiler is rated for a maximum working pressure that is determined by the applicable boiler code under which it is constructed and tested. When installed, it also must be equipped at a minimum with operation and safety controls and pressure/temperature-relief devices mandated by such codes.

Fuel Used

Boilers may be designed to burn coal, wood, various grades of fuel oil, waste oil, or various types of fuel gas, or to operate as electric boilers. A boiler designed for one specific fuel type may not be convertible to another type of fuel. Some boilers can be adapted to burn coal, oil, or gas. Several designs accommodate firing oil or gas, and other designs allow firing dual-fuel-burning equipment. Accommodating various fuel-burning equipment is a fundamental concern of boiler manufacturers, who can furnish details to a specifying engineer. The manufacturer is responsible for performance and rating according to the code or standard for the fuel used (see section on Performance Codes and Standards).

Construction Materials

Most noncondensing boilers are made with cast iron sections or steel. Some small boilers are made of copper or copper-clad steel. Condensing boilers are typically made of stainless steel or aluminum because copper, cast iron, and carbon steel will corrode because of acidic condensate.

Cast-iron sectional boilers generally are designed according to ASME Section IV requirements and range in size from 10 kW to 4.1 MW gross output. They are constructed of individually cast sections, assembled into blocks (assemblies) of sections. Push or screw nipples, gaskets, and/or an external header join the sections pressure-tight and provide passages for the water, steam, and products of combustion. The number of sections assembled determines the boiler size and energy rating. Sections may be vertical or horizontal, the vertical design being more common (Figures 1A and 1C).

The boiler may be **dry-base** (the combustion chamber is beneath the fluid-backed sections), as in Figure 1B; **wet-base** (the combus-

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.1, Hydronic and Steam Equipment and Systems.

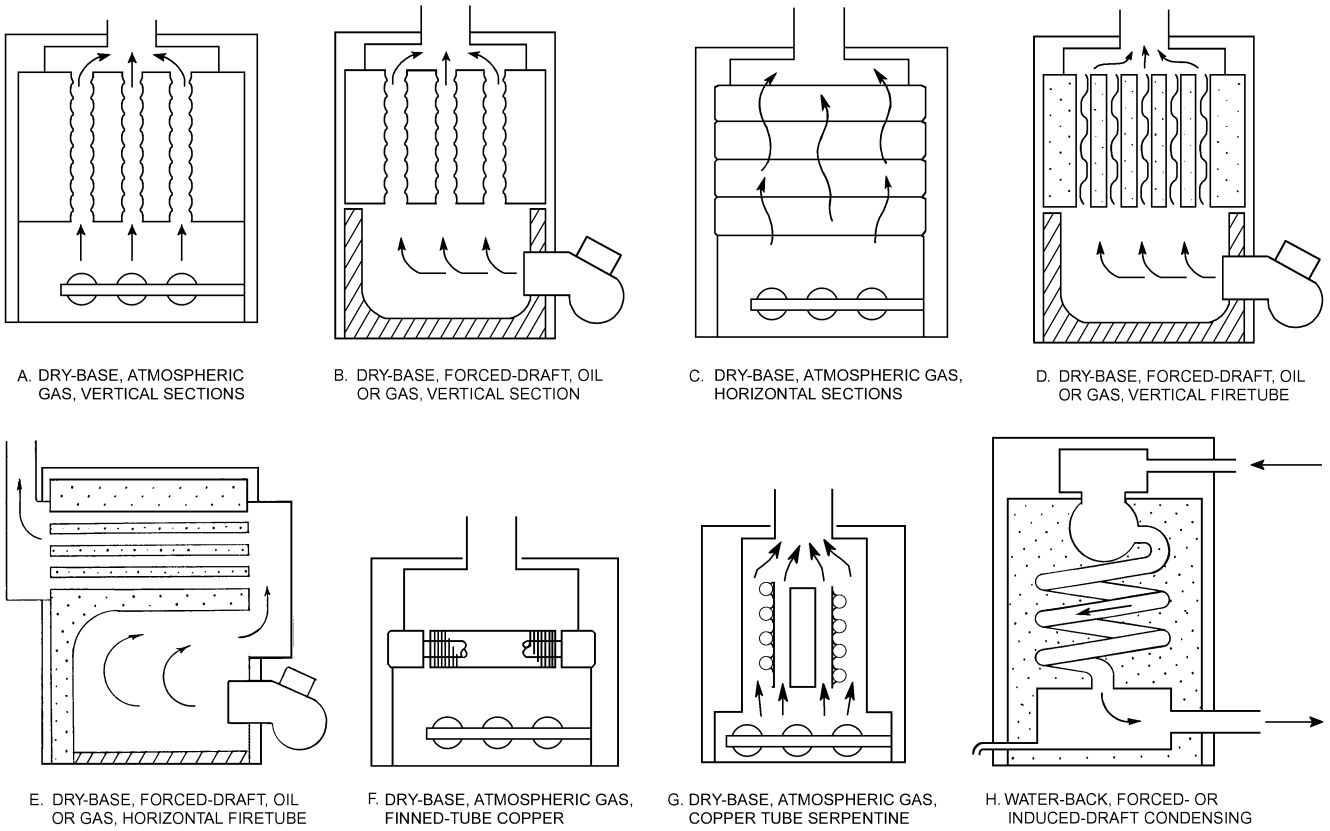

Fig. 1 Residential Boilers

tion chamber is surrounded by fluid-backed sections, except for necessary openings), as in Figure 2A; or **wet-leg** (the combustion chamber top and sides are enclosed by fluid-backed sections), as in Figure 2B.

The three types of boilers can be designed to be equally efficient. Testing and rating standards apply equally to all three types. The wet-base design is easiest to adapt for combustible floor installations. Applicable codes usually demand a floor temperature under the boiler no higher than 50 K above room temperature. A steam boiler at 102°C or a water boiler at 116°C may not meet this requirement without appropriate floor insulation. Large cast-iron boilers are also made as water-tube units with external headers (Figure 2C).

Steel boilers generally range in size from 15 kW to the largest boilers made. Designs are constructed to either ASME SCI or SCIV (or other applicable code) requirements. They are fabricated into one assembly of a given size and rating, usually by welding. The heat exchange surface past the combustion chamber is usually an assembly of vertical, horizontal, or slanted tubes. Boilers of the fire-tube design contain flue gases in tubes completely submerged in fluid (Figures 1D and 1E show residential units, and Figures 3A to 3D and Figure 4A show commercial units). Water-tube boilers contain fluid inside tubes with tube pattern arrangement providing for the combustion chamber (Figures 4C and 4D). The internal configuration may accommodate one or more flue gas passes. As with cast-iron sectional boilers, dry-base, wet-leg, or wet-base designs may be used. Most small steel boilers are of the dry-base, vertical fire-tube type (Figure 1D).

Larger boilers usually incorporate horizontal or slanted tubes; both fire-tube and water-tube designs are used. A popular horizontal fire-tube design for medium and large steel boilers is the **scotch marine**, which is characterized by a central fluid-backed cylindrical combustion chamber, surrounded by fire-tubes accommodating two

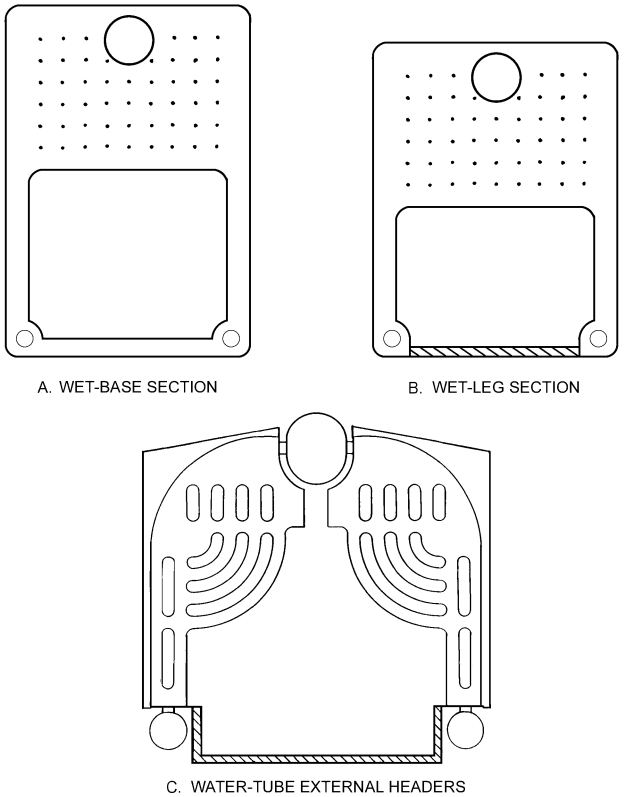

Fig. 2 Cast-Iron Commercial Boilers

or more flue gas passes, all within an outer shell (Figures 3A to 3D). In another horizontal fire-tube design, the combustion chamber has a similar central fluid-backed combustion chamber surrounded by fire tubes accommodating two or more flue gas passes, all within an outer shell. However, this design uses a dry base and wet leg (or mud leg) (Figure 4A).

Copper boilers are usually some variation of the water-tube boiler. Parallel finned copper tube coils with headers, and serpentine copper tube units are most common (Figures 1F and 1G). Some are offered as wall-hung residential boilers. The commercial bent water-tube design is shown in Figure 4B. Natural gas is the usual fuel for copper boilers.

Stainless steel boilers usually are designed to operate with condensing flue gases. Most are single-pass, fire-tube design and are generally resistant to thermal shock. ASME limits operating temperatures to 99°C and 1103 kPa (gage) working pressure.

Aluminum boilers are also usually designed to operate with condensing flue gases. Typical designs incorporate either cast aluminum boiler sections or integrally finned aluminum tubing. ASME limits operating temperatures to 93°C and working pressure to 345 kPa (gage).

Type of Draft

Draft is the pressure difference that causes air and/or fuel to flow through a boiler or chimney. A **natural draft boiler** is designed to operate with a negative pressure in the combustion chamber and in the flue connection. The pressure difference is created by the tendency of hot gases to rise up a chimney or by the height of the boiler up to the draft control device. In a **mechanical draft boiler**, a fan or blower or other machinery creates the required pressure difference. These boilers may be either forced draft or induced draft. In a **forced-draft boiler**, air is forced into the combustion chamber to maintain a positive pressure in the combustion chamber and/or the space between the tubing and the jacket (breaching). In an **induced-draft boiler**, air is drawn into the combustion chamber to maintain a negative pressure in the combustion chamber (see Chapter 35 for a more detailed discussion on draft).

Condensing or Noncondensing

Traditionally designed boilers must operate without condensing the flue gas in the boiler. This precaution was necessary to prevent corrosion of cast-iron, steel, or copper parts. Hot-water units were operated at 60°C minimum water temperature to prevent this corrosion and to reduce the likelihood of thermal shock.

Because a higher boiler efficiency can be achieved with a lower water temperature, the condensing boiler allows the flue gas water vapor to condense and drain. Full condensing boilers are now available from a large number of manufacturers. These boilers are specifically designed for operation with the low return water temperatures found in hot-water reset, water-source heat pump, two-pipe fan-coil, and reheat systems. Two types of commercial condensing boilers are shown in Figure 5. Figure 6 shows a typical relationship of overall condensing boiler efficiency to return water temperature. The dew point of 55°C shown in the figure varies with the percentage of hydrogen in the fuel and oxygen/carbon dioxide ratio, or excess air, in the flue gases. A condensing boiler is shown in Figure 1H. Condensing boilers can be of the fire-tube, water-tube, cast-iron, and cast-aluminum sectional design.

Condensing boilers are generally provided with high-turndown modulating burners and are more efficient than noncondensing boilers at any return water temperature (RWT), including noncondensing-temperature applications. Efficiencies of noncondensing boilers must be limited to avoid potential condensing and corrosion. Further efficiencies can be gained by using lower RWT or higher Δt as recommended by ASHRAE. For example, a natural gas condensing boiler operating with 15°C RWT in a water-source heat

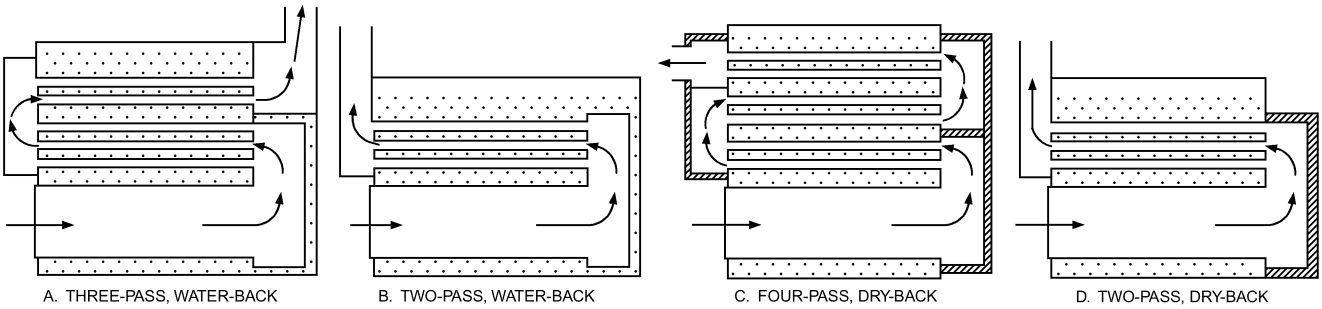

Fig. 3 Scotch Marine Commercial Boilers

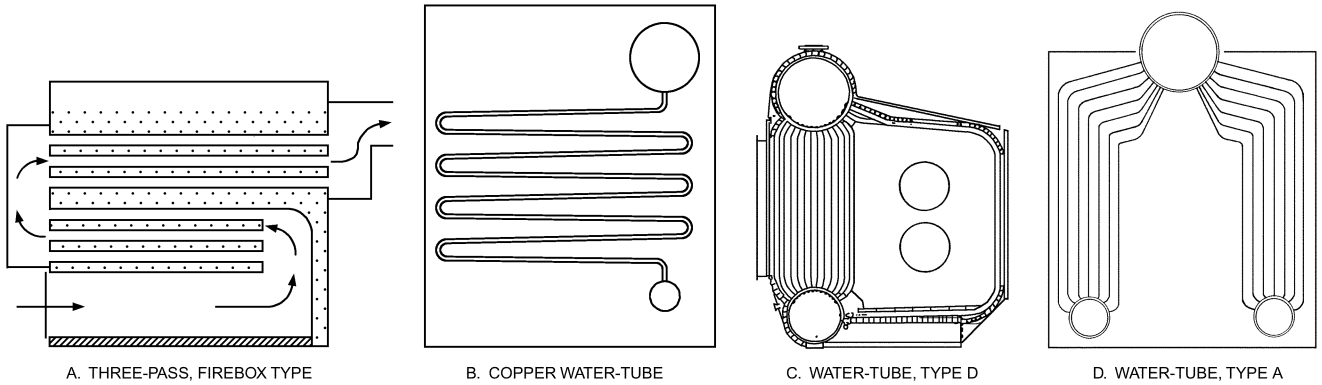

Fig. 4 Commercial Fire-Tube and Water-Tube Boilers

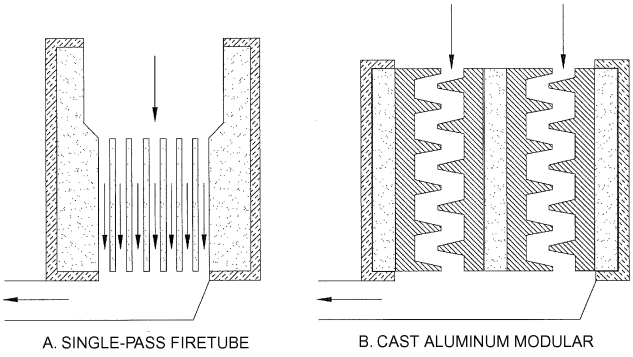

Fig. 5 Commercial Condensing Boilers

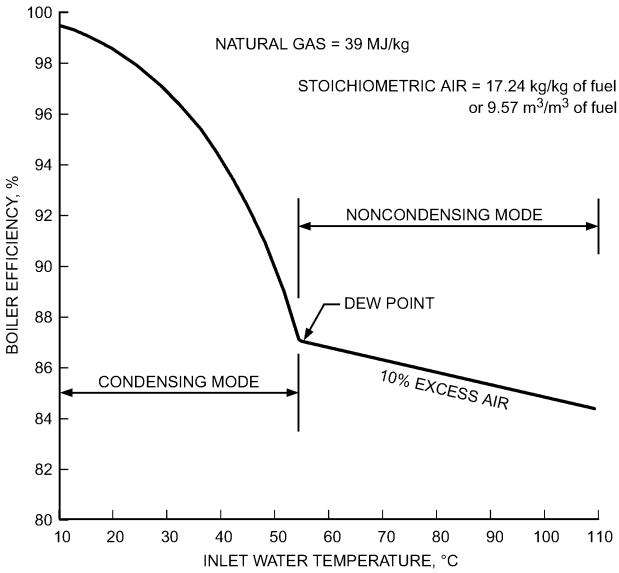

Fig. 6 Effect of Inlet Water Temperature on Efficiency of Condensing Boilers

pump application has potential boiler efficiency in excess of 98% (Figure 6).

For maximum reliability and durability over extended product life, condensing boilers should be constructed for corrosion resistance throughout the fireside combustion chamber and heat exchanger.

Noncondensing heat plant efficiency may in some cases be improved with the use of external flue gas-to-water economizers. The condensing medium may include domestic hot-water (DHW) preheat, steam condensate or hot-water return, fresh-water makeup, or other fluid sources in the 20 to 55°C range. The medium can also be used as a source of heat recovery in the HVAC system. Be sure to protect the noncondensing boiler from the low-temperature water return in the event of economizer service or control failure.

Figure 7 shows how dew point varies with a change in the percentages of oxygen/carbon dioxide for natural gas. Boilers that operate with a combustion efficiency and oxygen and carbon dioxide concentrations in the flue gas such that the flue gas temperature falls between the dew point and the dew point plus 80 K should be avoided, unless the venting is designed for condensation. This temperature typically occurs with boilers operating between 83 and 87% efficiency, and the flue gas has an oxygen concentration of 7 to 10% and the carbon dioxide is 6 to 8%. Chapter 35 gives further details on chimneys.

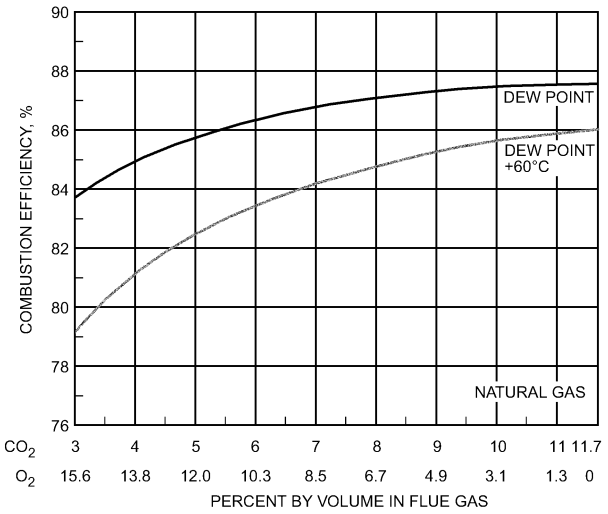

Fig. 7 Relationship of Dew Point, Carbon Dioxide, and Combustion Efficiency for Natural Gas

The condensing portion of these boilers may require special material or operating techniques to resist the corrosive effects of the condensing flue gases. In the past, typical cast iron, carbon steel, and copper were not suitable materials for the condensing section of a boiler. Certain stainless steels and aluminum alloys were suitable. However, advances in design, controls, and manufacturing have allowed materials such as cast iron to be used where they previously could not be; as with all products, consult the manufacturer for proper application. Commercial boiler installations can be adapted to condensing operation by adding a condensing heat exchanger in the flue gas vent.

Heat exchangers in the flue gas venting require a condensing medium such as (1) low pressure steam condensate or hot water return, (2) domestic water service, (3) fresh water makeup, or (4) other fluid sources in the 20 to 55°C range. The medium can also be a source of heat recovery in HVAC systems.

Wall-Hung Boilers

Wall-hung boilers are a type of small residential gas-fired boiler developed to conserve space in buildings such as apartments and condominiums. These boilers are popular in Europe. The most common designs are mounted on outer walls. Combustion air enters through a pipe from the outdoors, and flue products are vented directly through another pipe to the outdoors. In some cases, the air intake pipe and vent pipe are concentric. Other designs mount adjacent to a chimney for venting and use indoor air for combustion. These units may be condensing or noncondensing. Because these boilers are typically installed in the living space, provisions for proper venting and combustion air supply are very important.

Integrated (Combination) Boilers

Integrated boilers are relatively small, residential boilers that combine space heating and water heating in one appliance. They are usually wall mounted, but may also be floor standing. They operate primarily on natural gas and are practical to install and operate. The most common designs have an additional heat exchanger and a storage tank to provide domestic hot water. Some designs (particularly European) do not have a storage tank. Instead, they use a larger heat exchanger and the appropriate burner input to provide instantaneous domestic hot water.

Electric Boilers

Electric boilers are a separate class of boiler. Because no combustion occurs, a boiler heating surface and flue gas venting are unnecessary. The heating surface is the surface of the electric elements or electrodes immersed in the boiler water. The design of electric boilers is largely determined by the shape and heat release rate of the electric elements used. Electric boiler manufacturers' literature describes available size, shapes, voltages, ratings, and methods of control.

Heat Pump Boilers

Heat pump boiler, different from electric boilers, use refrigeration cycles to either absorb heat from the air or ground around the unit. The main components of a heat pump include an evaporative heat exchanger, a compressor, a condensing heat exchanger. Other components exist depending on the application and complexity as designed by the manufacturer. Like an electric boiler, no combustion occurs, and flue gas venting is unnecessary, but boiler surface area is still important. The heating surface is the surface of a heat exchanger that passes refrigerant on one side of the equipment, and boiler water on the other. Depending on the source of the heat, either water or air, one will have an additional heat exchanger designed for that medium, to complement heating surface area. The design of a heat pump boiler revolves around the operating temperature range of the equipment and the size of the heat exchanger attached to the appliance. Heat pump manufacturers' literature describes available size, shapes, voltages, ratings, and methods of control. This technology is currently under development, where refrigerants, compressor, and exchanger design may vary depending on the application of the three main components.

2. SELECTION PARAMETERS

Boiler selection depends on many variables of the individual application, including operating characteristics of actual loads; load distribution; total heating demand on the boiler plant; number of boilers in the plant; operational characteristics of individual boilers; and the whole boiler, burner, and control package.

The load's operational characteristics drive boiler selection. The purpose of boilers is not to make steam or hot water, but rather to supply heating as required by the process. Space heating can be accomplished with water or low-pressure steam. It is often possible to use lower water temperatures and a very efficient condensing boiler. An extremely wide range of products exist for this market. In industrial or institutional buildings, a process may require high-temperature hot water or high-pressure steam; this is a more specialized market and process loads require careful review. Often, the initial warm-up of a process load is very large and the loads are intermittent. Where a space-heating load is (after start-up) relatively constant, process loads can cause sudden increases and decreases in heating demand.

High-pressure steam or high-temperature hot water allow for economical distribution on large systems. A substantial part of the first cost of a new system is often distribution piping; there also are consequences on the operational cost to distribute the load. It may be appropriate to use a system with a high energy density for larger systems. Trade-offs of this approach include additional equipment to support a high-temperature and -pressure system, as well as lower system efficiency.

The boiler plant should be sized for the maximum system load. This is not merely the sum of connected loads, but should also take in to account piping loss, warm-up loads, possible diversity, etc. The plant also must operate at the minimum load, so the boiler should have sufficient turndown so that the boiler does not cycle excessively. It also must be able to increase or decrease its output with the load. If the load has a short burst of high instantaneous demand, a boiler with a high thermal capacity may be appropriate. If the load increases steadily and then remains for a long period, then a boiler with lower thermal mass but a quick response may be preferred. The designer should not only calculate the maximum but also the low load, and estimate the average load.

It is sometimes advantageous to split the load among multiple boilers. Splitting the load allows the plant to meet a seasonal high maximum and improves plant turndown in the shoulder season, and can increase efficiency for loads that tend to vary over the course of the year. Another factor to consider when selecting the number of boilers to be installed is redundancy. Redundant boilers allow for a more flexible maintenance schedule and possible future expansion. Also, consider plant layout and physical restrictions on the plant. An important issue is that, once a boiler reaches a certain size or pressure/temperature, many jurisdictions require an operating engineer to be always on site.

Once the system characteristics are established, the maximum load and general architectural of the plant can be selected. Important performance characteristics for base boiler selection include efficiency, part-load efficiency, and available fuels.

The physical boiler should be selected with burner and controls package. None of these elements operate independently of the others; they must operate as a whole. Each component of the boiler system affects

- Emissions
- Energy efficiency
- Indoor air quality (IAQ)
- System turndown
- System sensitivity

For IAQ purposes, it may be advantageous to have two boiler systems: a low-temperature hot-water heating system on outdoor reset control (60 to 32°C), and a clean-steam boiler for sterilizers and humidifiers.

The codes and standards outlined in the section on Performance Codes and Standards include requirements for minimum efficiency, maximum temperature, burner operating characteristics, and safety control. Test agency certification and labeling, which are published in boiler manufacturers' catalogs and shown on boiler rating plates, are generally sufficient for determining boiler steady-state operating characteristics. However, for noncondensing commercial and industrial boilers, these ratings typically do not consider part-load or seasonal efficiency, which is less than steady-state efficiency. Condensing boilers, generally provided with modulating burners, provide higher part- and full-load efficiency. Some boilers are not tested and rated by a recognized agency, and therefore do not bear the label of an agency. Nonrated boilers (rated and warranted only by the manufacturer) are used when jurisdictional codes or standards do not require a rating agency label. As previously indicated, almost without exception, both rated and nonrated boilers are of ASME code construction and are marked accordingly.

Boiler selection should be based on a competent review of the following parameters:

All Boilers

- Application of terminal unit selection
- Applicable code under which the boiler is constructed and tested
- Gross boiler heat output
- Part- versus full-load efficiency (life-cycle cost)
- Total heat transfer surface area
- Water content mass or volume
- Auxiliary power requirement
- Cleaning and service access provisions for fireside and waterside heat transfer surfaces
- Space requirement and piping arrangement
- Water treatment requirement

- Operating personnel capabilities and maintenance/operation requirements
- Regulatory requirements for emissions, fuel usage/storage

Fuel-Fired Boilers

- Combustion chamber (furnace volume)
- Internal flow pattern of combustion products
- Combustion air and venting requirements
- Fuel availability/capability

Steam Boilers

- Steam quality
- Condensate recovery system design

3. EFFICIENCY: INPUT AND OUTPUT RATINGS

The efficiency of fuel-burning boilers is defined in the following ways: combustion, overall, and seasonal. However, manufacturers are not required to test or publish efficiencies that coincide with these industry definitions. Further explanation of boiler test requirements is found in the section on Performance Codes and Standards.

Combustion efficiency is input minus stack (flue gas outlet) loss, divided by input, and generally ranges from 75 to 86% for most noncondensing boilers. Condensing boilers generally rated in the range of 88 to 99% combustion efficiency.

Overall (or **thermal**) **efficiency** is gross energy output divided by energy input. Gross output is measured in the steam or water leaving the boiler and depends on the characteristics of the individual installation. Overall efficiency of electric boilers is generally 92 to 96%. Overall efficiency is lower than combustion efficiency by the percentage of heat lost from the outer surface of the boiler (radiation loss or jacket loss) and by off-cycle energy losses (for applications where the boiler cycles on and off). Overall efficiency can be precisely determined only under controlled laboratory test conditions, directly measuring the fuel input and the heat absorbed by the water or steam of the boiler. Precise efficiency measurements are generally not performed under field conditions because of the inability to control the required parameters and the high cost involved in performing such an analysis. An approximate combustion efficiency for noncondensing boilers can be determined under any operating condition by measuring flue gas temperature and percentage of CO_2 or O_2 in the flue gas and by consulting a chart or table for the fuel being used. The approximate combustion efficiency of a condensing boiler must include the energy transferred by condensation in the flue gas.

Seasonal efficiency is the actual operating efficiency that the boiler will achieve during the heating season at various loads. Because most heating boilers operate at part load, the part-load efficiency, including heat losses when the boiler is off, has a great effect on the seasonal efficiency. The difference in seasonal efficiency between a boiler with an on/off firing rate and one with modulating firing rate can be appreciable if the airflow through the boiler is modulated along with the fuel input. Figure 8 shows how efficiency increases at part load for a typical boiler equipped with a burner that can fire at reduced inputs while modulating both fuel and air. This increase in efficiency comes from the increase in the ratio of heat exchanger surface area to heat input as the firing rate is reduced.

4. PERFORMANCE CODES AND STANDARDS

Commercial heating boilers (i.e., boilers with inputs of 90 kW and larger) at present are only tested for full-load steady-state efficiency according to standards developed by either (1) the Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute (AHRI), (2) the American Gas Association (AGA), or (3) Underwriters Laboratories (UL).

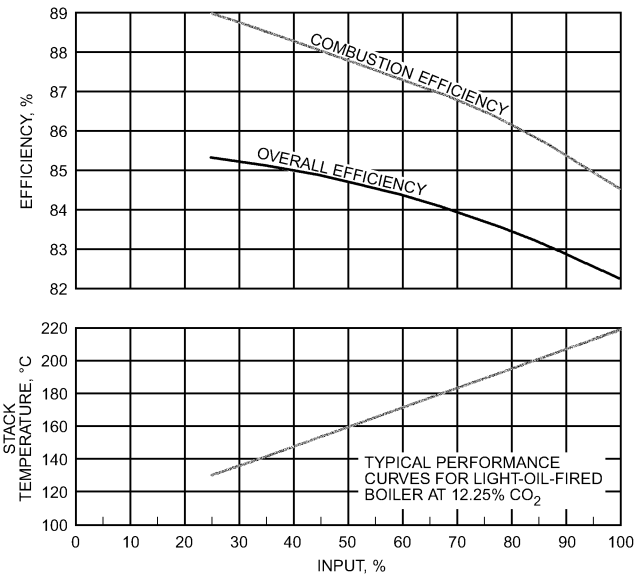

Fig. 8 Boiler Efficiency as Function of Fuel and Air Input

AHRI *Standard* 1500 for rating cast-iron sectional, steel, and copper boilers bases performance on controlled test conditions for fuel inputs of 117 kW and larger. The gross output obtained by the test is limited by such factors as flue gas temperature, draft, CO_2 in the flue gas, and minimum overall efficiency. This standard applies primarily to oil-fired and natural gas equipment; however, it is also applied to all forced-draft gas-fired or dual-fueled units.

Gas boilers are generally design-certified by an accredited testing laboratory based on tests conducted in accordance with ANSI/CSA *Standard* Z21.13 or UL *Standard* 795. Note that the Z21.13 test procedure may be applied to both condensing and noncondensing boilers. This test uses 27°C return water temperature, 56 K temperature differential, steady-state, full-load operation, and allows the presence of condensate to be ignored. Efficiencies published under this test procedure are generally not achieved in actual operation.

Instead of the HI-GAMA, AGA, and UL standards, test procedures for commercial-industrial and packaged fire-tube boilers are often performed based on ASME *Performance Test Code* 4 (2023). Units are tested for performance under controlled test conditions with minimum required levels of efficiency. Further, the American Boiler Manufacturers Association (ABMA) publishes several guidelines for the care and operation of commercial and industrial boilers and for control parameters.

Residential heating boilers (i.e., all gas- and oil-fired boilers with inputs less than 90 kW in the United States) are rated according to standards developed by the U.S. Department of Energy (DOE). The procedure determines both on- and off-cycle losses based on a laboratory test. The test results are applied to a computer program, which simulates an installation and predicts an annual fuel utilization efficiency (AFUE). The steady-state efficiency developed during the test is similar to combustion efficiency and is the basis for determining DOE **heating capacity**, a term similar to gross output. The AFUE represents the part-load efficiency at the average outdoor temperature and load for a typical boiler installed in the United States. Although this value is useful for comparing different boiler models, it is not meant to represent actual efficiency for a specific installation.

5. SIZING

Boiler sizing is the selection of boiler output capacity to meet connected load. The boiler gross output is the rate of heat delivered

by the boiler to the system under continuous firing at rated input. Net rating (I-B-R rating) is gross output minus a fixed percentage (called the piping and pickup factor) to allow for an estimated average piping heat loss, plus an added load for initially heating up the water in a system (sometimes called **pickup**). This I-B-R piping and pickup factor is 1.15 for water boilers and ranges from 1.27 to 1.33 for steam boilers, with the smaller number applying as the boilers get larger. The net rating is calculated by dividing the gross output by the appropriate piping and pickup factor.

Piping loss is variable. If all piping is in the space defined as load, loss is zero. If piping runs through unheated spaces, heat loss from the piping may be much higher than accounted for by the fixed net rating factor. Pickup is also variable. When the actual connected load is less than design load, the pickup factor may be unnecessary.

On the coldest day, extra output (boiler and radiation) is needed to pick up the load from a shutdown or low night setback. If night setback is not used, or if no extended shutdown occurs, no pickup load exists. Standby capacity for pickup, if needed, can be in the form of excess capacity in baseload boilers or in a standby boiler.

If piping and pickup losses are negligible, the boiler gross output can be considered the design load. If piping loss and pickup load are large or variable, those loads should be calculated and equivalent gross boiler capacity added. Boiler capacity must be matched to the terminal unit and system delivery capacity. That is, if the boiler output is greater than the terminal output, the water temperature rises and the boiler cycles on the high-limit control, delivering an average input that is much lower than the boiler gross output. Significant oversizing of the boiler may result in a much lower overall boiler efficiency.

6. BURNER TYPES

Burners for installation on boilers are grouped generally by fuel used and pressure type. Fuel groupings include fuel oil, natural gas, propane, wood, or coal. A **dual-fuel burner** may use two or more fuels (e.g., No. 2 fuel oil and natural gas). The pressure type refers to whether the burner is atmospheric or a fan is used for pressurization. In **atmospheric burners**, firing generally natural gas or propane, the fuel is introduced across a drilled orifice manifold where it contacts combustion air and is ignited. The chimney or flue produces a natural draft to remove the products of combustion. In **power burners**, a fan pushes combustion air into a burner or combustion chamber under positive pressure where it mixes with the fuel and is ignited. The products of combustion are pushed through the combustion chamber and boiler by the fan, then flow through the chimney by natural draft, or induced draft caused by a chimney fan.

Burners may also be classified by method of fuel atomization. In **pressure atomization**, fuel oil at 550 to 2070 kPa (gage) is pumped through a nozzle orifice to create a fine mist. The fuel-rich mist is mixed with combustion air provided by a fan and is ignited at the burner. In **steam atomization**, generally used on heavy grades of fuel oil, high-pressure steam is mixed with pressurized fuel oil through a nozzle orifice to heat the oil and reduce the oil's viscosity to create a fine mist. The mist is mixed with combustion air provided by a fan and is ignited at the burner.

7. BOILER CONTROLS

Boiler controls provide automatic regulation of burner and boiler performance to ensure safe and efficient operation. Operating and combustion controls regulate the rate of fuel input in response to a signal representing load change (demand), so that the average boiler output equals the load within some accepted tolerance. Water level and flame safety controls cut off fuel flow when unsafe conditions develop. The National Fire Protection Association (NFPA) *Code* 85, Boiler and Combustion Systems Hazard Code, is generally accepted as the governing code for boiler control systems. Other requirements from insurance companies or local governing agencies may also be applicable. Often, the governing agency having jurisdiction may specify specific requirements that the heating system designer or specifying engineer must comply with in the design. It is essential that the designer or engineer determine the applicable codes, and specify the controls and skills needed to complete the control system.

Operating Controls

Steam boilers are operated by boiler-mounted, pressure-actuated controls, which vary fuel input to the boiler. Traditional examples of burner controls were on/off, high/low/off, and modulating. Modulating controls infinitely vary fuel input from 100% down to a selected minimum set point. The ratio of maximum to minimum is the turndown ratio. The minimum input is usually between 5 and 33% (i.e., 20 to 1 down to 3 to 1 ratios); input depends on the size and type of fuel-burning equipment and system. High turndown ratios in noncondensing boilers must be considered carefully to prevent condensation at lower firing rates.

Hot-water boilers are operated by temperature-actuated controls that are usually mounted on the boiler. Traditionally, burner controls were the same as for steam boilers (i.e., on/off, high/low/off, and modulating). Modulating controls typically offer more precise water temperature control and higher efficiency than on/off or high/low controls, if airflow through the boiler is modulated along with fuel input.

Boiler reset controls can enhance the efficiency of hot-water boilers. These controls may operate with any of the burner controls mentioned previously. They automatically change the high-limit set point of the boiler to match the variable building load demands caused by changing outdoor temperatures. By keeping boiler water temperature as low as possible, efficiency is enhanced and standby losses are reduced.

Microprocessor-Based Control Systems. The introduction of microprocessor-based control systems has changed traditional operating controls on boilers. In the past, smaller boilers were equipped with on/off or high/low/off electromagnetic-relay-based burner operating controls with mercury switches, with larger boilers provided with modulating controls. The low cost and greater efficiency of microprocessor-based control systems has resulted in the availability of such controls on small factory-packaged boilers, and nearly all medium and larger boiler installations. The recent introduction of integrated combustion and burner safeguard microprocessor controllers has accelerated this availability.

Traditionally, most burner installations used a single actuator to drive the combustion air damper and fuel ratio valves through common linkages. Such installations were called **single-jackshaft** controls. The fuel ratio valves often used set screw cams to produce efficient combustion throughout the firing range of the burner. Tuning the burner involved positioning the set screws to adjust the cam, which in turn regulated the fuel ratio at various firing rates. Tuning was often cumbersome, and easily lost when set screws loosened. Single-jackshaft control also invariably meant compromises were made in tuning, generally resulting in inefficient combustion with high excess air ratios at low firing rates. Current technology eliminates the single-jackshaft, using "linkless" burners with individual actuators controlling the combustion air damper and each fuel valve. With the high-speed processing ability of the microprocessors, individual actuators can quickly and accurately respond to changes in load, ensuring efficient combustion throughout the full firing range. When oxygen analyzers are installed to measure the oxygen content of the flue gas, microprocessor combustion controllers can modulate the combustion air damper and fuel valve actuators to ensure optimal combustion efficiency.

Water Level Controls

Maintaining proper water level in a boiler is of paramount concern. Should water level drop below a preset limit, damage may occur from overheating of boiler surfaces, resulting in cracking of cast-iron sections, or plastic deformation of steel tubes and tubesheets. Such a condition is known as **dry-firing** of the boiler. Installation of a low-water cutoff switch to stop fuel flow to the burner is necessary to prevent damage from dry firing.

To maintain proper water levels, different methods may be used. Smaller boilers generally use a boiler feedwater controller to cause a feedwater pump to pump water directly to the boiler to maintain proper water level. In larger installations, a feedwater piping loop may serve several boilers in parallel. In such an installation, each boiler has a feedwater valve controlled by a feedwater controller mounted on the boiler. The controller modulates the feedwater valve to maintain proper water level in the boiler. Simple feedwater control systems use water level as the control parameter to modulate the feedwater valve. Such systems are considered **single-element** feedwater systems. In larger boiler installations where steam is generated, the steam flow rate or rate of change of steam pressure may also be monitored with a signal sent to the feedwater controller. If the controller is programmed to modulate the feedwater valve based on both water level and steam flow rate or rate of change of pressure, the feedwater control system is referred to a **two-element** system. A **three-element** system uses water level, steam flow rate, and rate of pressure change to modulate the feedwater valve.

8. FLAME SAFEGUARD CONTROLS

Flame safeguard controls monitor flame condition and shut fuel flow to the burner in the event of an unsafe condition. The safety circuit of a flame safeguard control system typically includes switch contacts for low-water cutoff, high limits, air proving switches, redundant safety and operating controls, and flame monitors. Flame monitors typically use either infrared or ultraviolet scanners to monitor flame condition and deactivate the burner in the event of nonignition or other unsafe flame condition. Flame safeguard controllers usually use preprogrammed algorithms to operate a burner and cycle it through stages of operation. The first stage is a purge cycle wherein the boiler's combustion chamber is flushed with combustion air to remove any unspent fuel and products of combustion that remain from the previous cycle. After purging, the pilot flame is ignited and the main fuel introduced into the burner and ignited. In the absence of a pilot fuel, such as with direct electronic spark ignition, the main fuel is introduced and ignited. In either case, the flame monitor determines whether ignition has occurred and whether the resulting flame is proper. If ignition has failed, or flame is not indicated, the flame monitor cuts off fuel flow, causing a postpurge cycle to rid the combustion chamber of unspent fuel and products of combustion. On restart, the burner again starts with a purge cycle and repeats the steps to ignition. When proper flame is established, the flame safeguard control system allows the operating control or combustion control system to control or modulate the burner firing rate.

Traditionally, flame safeguard systems were separate controllers from operating or combustion control systems. With the advent of microprocessor-based control systems, separate microprocessors control the individual functions of flame safeguard and combustion control. Recently introduced burner controllers provide an integrated control with algorithms for both flame safeguard and combustion control.

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CHAPTER 33

FURNACES

Components 33.1
Heat Source Types 33.4
Commercial Equipment 33.5
Controls and Operating Characteristics 33.5
Equipment Selection 33.6
Calculations 33.8
Technical Data 33.8
Installation 33.9
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FURNACES are self-enclosed, permanently installed major appliances that provide heated air through ductwork to the space being heated. In addition, a furnace may provide the indoor fan necessary for circulating heated or cooled air from a split or single-package air conditioner or heat pump (see Chapter 10). Furnaces may be used in either residential or commercial applications, and may be grouped according to the following characteristics:

- Heat source: electricity, natural gas/propane (fan assisted, condensing or noncondensing), or oil (forced draft with power atomizing burner)
- Installation location: within conditioned space (indoors), or outside conditioned space (either outdoors, or inside the structure but not within the conditioned space)
- Combustion air source: direct vent (outdoor air) or indoor air
- Mounting arrangement and airflow: horizontal, vertical upflow, vertical downflow, or multiposition

Furnaces that use electricity as a heat source include one or more resistance-type heating elements that heats the circulating air either directly or through a metal sheath that encloses the resistance element. In gas- or oil-fired furnaces, combustion occurs in the heat exchanger sections or in a combustion chamber. Circulating air passes over the outer surfaces of a heat exchanger so that it does not contact the fuel or the products of combustion, which are passed to the outdoor atmosphere through a vent.

In North America, natural gas is the most common fuel supplied for residential heating, and the central-system forced-air furnace (Figure 1) is the most common way of heating with natural gas. This type of furnace is equipped with a blower to circulate air through the furnace enclosure, over the heat exchanger, and through the ductwork distribution system. A furnace such as that in Figure 1 is categorized as follows:

- Heat source: natural gas
- Mounting arrangement and airflow: vertical upflow
- Installation location: varies; usually inside the structure but not necessarily within the conditioned space
- Combustion air source: varies; high-efficiency furnaces usually are direct vent

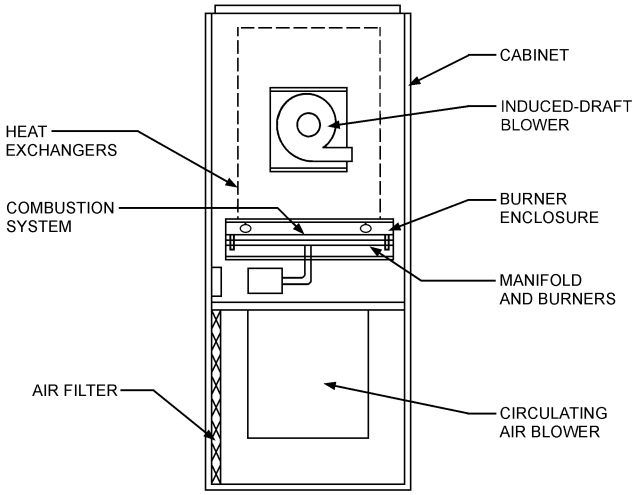

Fig. 1 Induced-Draft Gas Furnace

1. COMPONENTS

A typical furnace consists of the following basic components: (1) a cabinet or casing; (2) heat exchangers; (3) heat sources, including burners and controls; (4) venting components, such as an induced-draft blower; (5) a circulating air blower and motor; and (6) an air filter and other accessories such as a humidifier, electronic air cleaner, air-conditioning coil, or a combination of these elements.

Casing or Cabinet

The furnace casing is most commonly formed from painted cold-rolled steel. Access panels on the furnace allow access to those sections requiring service. The inside of the casing adjacent to the heat exchanger or electric heat elements is lined with a foil-faced blanket insulation and/or a metal radiation shield to reduce heat losses through the casing and to limit the outer surface temperature of the furnace. On some furnaces, the inside of the blower compartment is lined with insulation to acoustically dampen the blower noise. Commercial furnace cabinets may also include the indoor and outdoor air-conditioning or heat pump components.

New scrutiny of the airtightness of system ductwork has drawn attention to the furnace casing as a common source of leakage. ASHRAE *Standard* 193-2010 provides a method of test to determine the airtightness of forced-air HVAC equipment before field installation. The standard is cited in the U.S. Department of Energy (DOE) *ENERGY STAR*® Program Requirements Product Specification for Furnaces, Version 4.0 (DOE 2013).

Heat Exchangers

Furnaces with gas-fired burners have heat exchangers that are typically made either of left/right sets of formed parts that are joined together to form a clamshell, finless tubes bent into a compact form, or finned-tube (condensing) heat exchangers. Standard indoor furnace heat exchangers are generally made of alloy steel. Common corrosion-resistant materials include aluminized steel and stainless steel. Furnaces certified for use downstream of a cooling coil must have corrosion-resistant heat exchangers.

Some problems of heat exchanger corrosion and failure have been encountered because of exposure to halogen ions in flue gas. These problems were caused by combustion air contaminated by substances such as laundry bleach, cleaning solvents, and halogenated hydrocarbon refrigerants.

Heat exchangers of oil-fired furnaces are normally heavy-gage steel formed into a welded assembly. Hot flue products flow through the inside of the heat exchanger into the chimney, and conditioned

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.3, Central Forced Air Heating and Cooling Systems.

air flows over the outside of the heat exchanger and into the air supply plenum.

Heat Sources

Electric Heat Elements. Elements for electric furnaces are generally either open wire, open ribbon, or wire enclosed in a tube. Current is applied to the element and heats it through resistance of the material.

Burners and Internal Controls. Gas burners are most frequently made of stamped sheet metal, although cast iron is also used. Fabricated sheet metal burners may be made from cold-rolled steel coated with high-temperature paint or from a corrosion-resistant material such as stainless or aluminized steel. Burner material must meet the corrosion protection requirements of the specific application. Gas furnace burners may be of either the monoport or multiport type; the type used with a particular furnace depends on compatibility with the heat exchanger.

Gas furnace controls include an ignition device, gas valve, fan control, limit switch, and other components specified by the manufacturer. These controls allow gas to flow to the burners when heat is required. The most common ignition systems are (1) direct spark, and (2) hot-surface ignition. The section on Technical Data has further details on the function and performance of individual control components.

Oil furnaces are generally equipped with pressure-atomizing burners. The pump pressure and size of the injection nozzle orifice regulate the firing rate of the furnace. Electric ignition lights the burners. Other furnace controls, such as the blower switch and the limit switch, are similar to those used on gas furnaces.

Combustion Venting Components

Fan-assisted combustion furnaces use a small blower to induce flue products through the furnace. Induced-draft furnaces may or may not have a relief air opening, but they meet the same safety requirements regardless. Residential furnaces built since 1987 are equipped with a blocked-vent shutoff switch to shut down the furnace in case the vent becomes blocked.

Research into common venting of natural-draft appliances (water heaters) and fan-assisted combustion furnaces shows that nonpositive vent pressure systems may operate on a common vent. Refer to manufacturers' instructions for specific information.

Direct-vent furnaces use outdoor air for combustion. Outdoor air is supplied to the furnace combustion chamber by direct connections between the furnace and the outdoor air. If the vent or the combustion air supply becomes blocked, the furnace control system will shut down the furnace.

ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA 2.3 classifies venting systems. Central furnaces are categorized by temperature and pressure attained in the vent and by the steady-state efficiency attained by the furnace. Although ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA 2.3 uses 83% as the steady-state efficiency dividing central furnace categories, a general rule of thumb is as follows:

Category I: nonpositive vent pressure and flue loss of 17% or more

Category II: nonpositive vent pressure and flue loss less than 17%

Category III: positive vent pressure and flue loss of 17% or more

Category IV: positive vent pressure and flue loss less than 17%

Furnaces rated in accordance with ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA 2.3 that are not direct vent are marked to show that they are in one of these four venting categories.

Ducted-system, oil-fired, forced-air furnaces are usually forced draft.

Circulating Blowers and Motors

Centrifugal blowers with forward-curved blades of the double-inlet type are used in most forced-air furnaces. These blowers overcome the resistance of furnace air passageways, filters, and ductwork. They are usually sized to provide the additional air requirement for cooling and the static pressure required for the cooling coil. The blower may be a direct-drive type, with the blower wheel attached directly to the motor shaft, or it may be a belt-drive type, with a pulley and V-belt used to drive the blower wheel.

Electric motors used to drive furnace blowers are usually custom designed for each furnace model or model series. Direct-drive motors may be shaded-pole, permanent split-capacitor (PSC), or brushless permanent magnet. Speed may be varied by taps connected to extra windings in the motor. Belt-drive blower motors are normally split-phase or capacitor-start. The speed of belt-drive blowers is controlled by adjusting a variable-pitch drive pulley.

Electronically controlled, variable-speed motors using a brushless permanent magnet design are inherently more efficient than shaded-pole or PSC motors. The motor is controlled electronically by a microprocessor and electronic controls, which provides the ability to increase or decrease motor speed and maintain efficiency across a wide range of operating speeds.

In the United States, the DOE regulates energy efficiency of residential furnace fans. DOE has initiated a rulemaking to consider new energy conservation or use standards for furnace fans. For the current status of DOE regulations, visit www.energy.gov/eere/buildings/appliance-and-equipment-standards-program.

Filters and Other Accessories

Air Filters. An air filter in a forced-air furnace removes dust from the air that could reduce the effectiveness of the blower and heat exchanger(s), and may also help provide cleaner air for the indoor environment (see ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2). Filters installed in a forced-air furnace are often disposable. Permanent filters that may be washed or vacuum-cleaned and reinstalled are also used. The filter is always located in the circulating airstream ahead of the blower and heat exchanger. Because the air filter keeps airflow components of the furnace clean, it should be cleaned or replaced regularly to extend the life of the furnace components. See Chapters 10 and 29 for further information on air filters.

Humidifiers. These are not included as a standard part of the furnace package. However, one advantage of a forced-air heating system is that it offers the opportunity to control the relative humidity of the heated space at a comfortable level. Chapter 22 addresses various types of humidifiers used with forced-air furnaces.

Electronic Air Cleaners. These air cleaners may be much more effective than the air filter provided with the furnace, and they filter out much finer particles, including smoke and pollen. Electronic air cleaners create an electric field of high-voltage direct current in which dust particles are given a charge and collected on a plate having the opposite charge. The collected material is then cleaned periodically from the collector plate by the homeowner. Electronic air cleaners are mounted in the airstream entering the furnace. Chapter 29 has detailed information on filters.

Airflow Variations

The components of a forced-air furnace can be arranged in a variety of configurations to suit a residential heating system. The relative positions of the components in the different types of furnaces are as follows:

- **Upflow furnace.** In an upflow furnace (Figure 2), the blower is located beneath the heat exchanger and discharges vertically upward. Air enters through the bottom or the side of the blower compartment and leaves at the top. This furnace may be used in closets and utility rooms on the first floor or in basements, with

the return air ducted down to the blower compartment entrance.

Downflow furnace. In a downflow furnace (Figure 3), the blower is located above the heat exchanger and discharges downward. Air enters at the top and is discharged vertically at the bottom. This furnace is normally used with a perimeter heating system in a house without a basement. It is also used in upstairs furnace closets and utility rooms supplying conditioned air to both levels of a two-story house.

- **Horizontal furnace.** In a horizontal furnace, the blower is located beside the heat exchanger (Figure 4). Air enters at one end, travels horizontally through the blower and over the heat exchanger, and is discharged at the opposite end. This furnace is used for locations with limited head room such as attics and crawlspaces, or is suspended under a roof or floor or placed above a suspended ceiling. These units are often designed so that the components may be rearranged to allow installation with airflow from left to right or from right to left.
- **Multiposition (multipoise) furnace.** This furnace can be installed in more than one airflow configuration (e.g., upflow or horizontal; downflow or horizontal; or upflow, downflow, or horizontal). In some models, field conversion is necessary to accommodate an alternative installation.
- **Basement furnace.** The basement furnace (Figure 5) is a variation of the upflow furnace and requires less head room. The blower is located beside the heat exchanger at the bottom. Air enters the top of the cabinet, is drawn down through the blower, is discharged over the heat exchanger, and leaves vertically at the top. This type of furnace has become less popular because of the advent of short upflow furnaces.
- **Gravity furnace.** These furnaces are no longer available, and they are not common. This furnace has larger air passages through the casing and over the heat exchanger so that the buoyancy force created by the air being warmed circulates the air through the ducts. Wall furnaces that rely on natural convection (gravity) are discussed in Chapter 34.

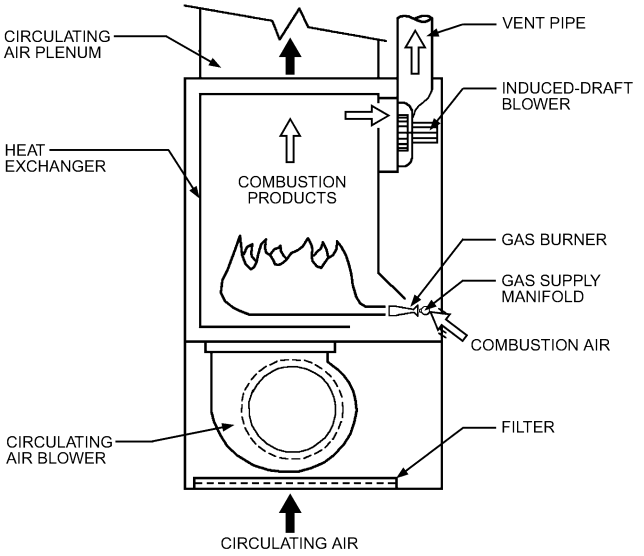

Fig. 2 Upflow Category I Furnace with Induced-Draft Blower

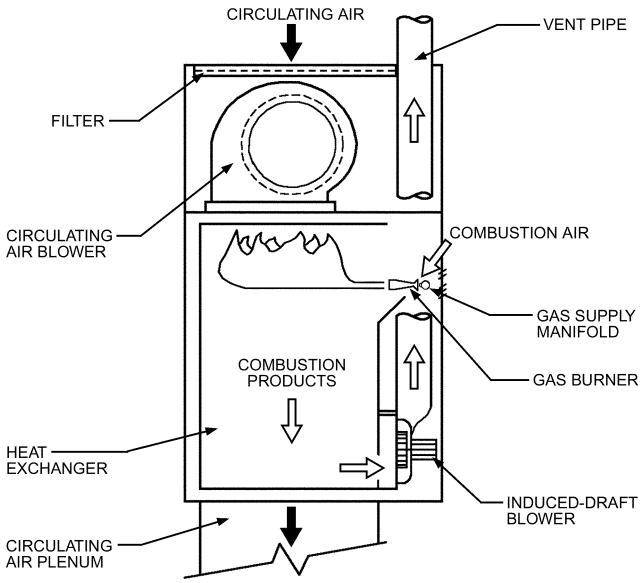

Fig. 3 Downflow (Counterflow) Category I Furnace with Induced-Draft Blower

Combustion System Variations

Gas-fired furnaces use a fan-assisted combustion system. Fan-assisted combustion furnaces have a combustion blower, which may be located either upstream or downstream from the heat exchangers (Figure 6). If the blower is located upstream, blowing the combustion air into the heat exchangers, the system is known as a forced-draft system. If the blower is downstream, the arrangement is known as an induced-draft system.

Direct-vent furnaces obtain combustion air from outside the structure. Mobile home furnaces must be of the direct-vent type.

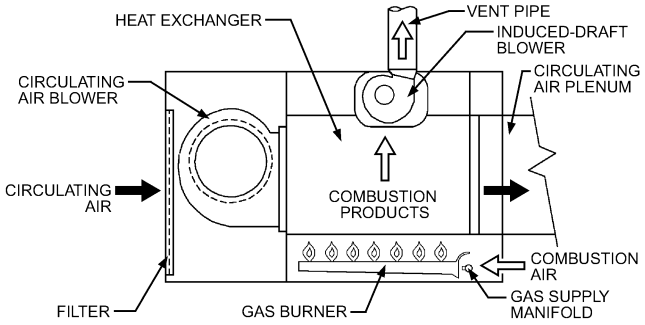

Fig. 4 Horizontal Category I Furnace with Induced-Draft Blower

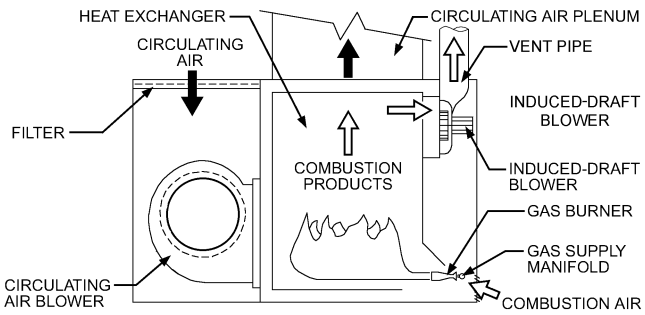

Fig. 5 Basement (Lowboy) Category I Furnace with Induced-Draft Blower

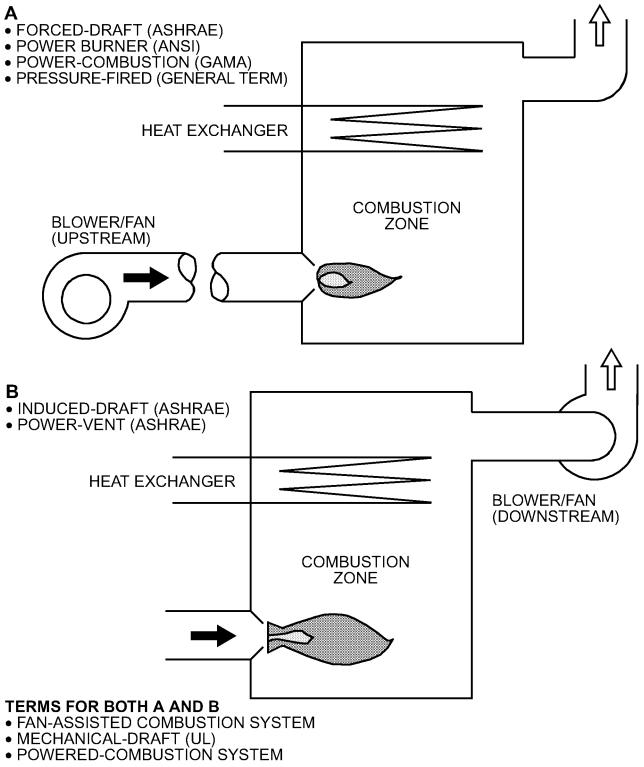

Fig. 6 Terminology Used to Describe Fan-Assisted Combustion

Indoor/Outdoor Furnace Variations

Central system residential furnaces are designed and certified for either indoor or outdoor use. Outdoor furnaces are normally horizontal flow and convertible to downflow.

The heating-only outdoor furnace is similar to the more common indoor horizontal furnace. The primary difference is that the outdoor furnace is weatherized; the motors and controls are sealed, and the exposed components are made of corrosion-resistant materials such as galvanized or aluminized steel.

A common style of outdoor furnace is the combination package unit. This unit is a combination of an air conditioner and a gas or electric furnace built into a single casing. The design varies, but the most common combination consists of an electric air conditioner coupled with a horizontal gas or electric furnace. The advantage is that much of the interconnecting piping and wiring is included in the unit.

2. HEAT SOURCE TYPES

Natural Gas and Propane Furnaces

Most manufacturers have their furnaces certified for both natural gas and propane. The major difference between natural gas and propane furnaces is the pressure at which the gas is injected from the manifold into the burners. For natural gas, the manifold pressure is usually controlled at 750 to 1000 Pa; for propane, the pressure is usually 2500 to 2700 Pa.

Because of the higher injection pressure and the greater heat content per volume of propane, there are certain physical differences between a natural gas furnace and a propane furnace. One difference is that the burner orifices must be smaller for propane furnaces. The gas valve regulator spring is also different. Sometimes it is necessary to change burners, but this is not normally required. Manufacturers sell conversion kits containing both the required parts and instructions to convert furnace operation from one gas to the other.

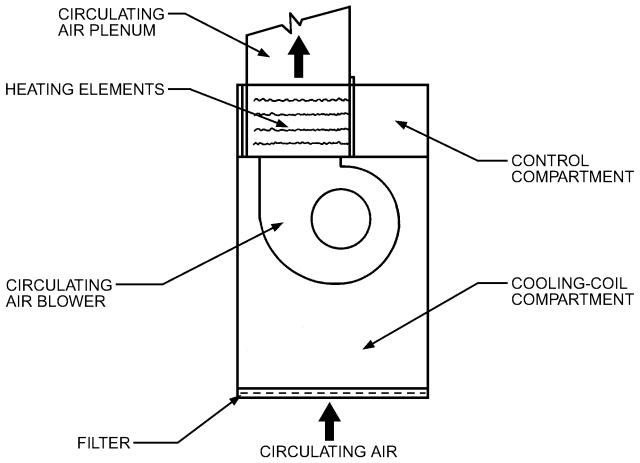

Fig. 7 Electric Forced-Air Furnace

Oil Furnaces

Indoor oil furnaces come in the same configurations as gas furnaces. They are available in upflow, downflow, horizontal, and lowboy configurations for ducted systems. Oil-fired outdoor furnaces and combination units are not common.

The major differences between oil and gas furnaces are in the combustion system, heat exchanger, and barometric draft regulator.

Electric Furnaces

Electric-powered furnaces come in a variety of configurations and have some similarities to gas- and oil-fired furnaces. However, when a furnace is used with an air conditioner, the cooling coil may be upstream from the blower and heaters. On gas- and oil-fired furnaces, the cooling coil is normally mounted downstream from the blower and heat exchangers so cold air leaving the cooling coil does not contact the heat exchangers, which could cause premature corrosion from condensation. If the cooling coil is upstream of the heat exchangers on a gas- or oil-fired product, the heat exchanger may require a mechanism to remove the condensed moisture.

Figure 7 shows a typical arrangement for an electric forced-air furnace. Air enters the bottom of the furnace and passes through the filter, then flows up through the cooling coil section into the blower. The electric heating elements are immediately above the blower so that the high-velocity air discharging from the blower passes directly through the heating elements.

The furnace casing, air filter, and blower are similar to equivalent gas furnace components. The heating elements are made in modular form, with 5 kW capacity being typical for each module. Electric furnace controls include electric overload protection, contactor, limit switches, and a fan control switch. The overload protection may be either fuses or circuit breakers. The contactor brings the electric heat modules on. The fan control switch and limit switch functions are similar to those of the gas furnace, but one limit switch is usually used for each heating element.

Frequently, electric furnaces are made from modular sections; for example, the coil box, blower section, and electric heat section are made separately and then assembled in the field. Regardless of whether the furnace is made from a single-piece casing or a modular casing, it is generally a multiposition unit. Thus, the same unit may be used for upflow, downflow, or horizontal installations.

When an electric heating appliance is sold without a cooling coil, it is known as an electric furnace. The same appliance is called a fan-coil air handler when it has an air-conditioning coil already installed. When the unit is used as the indoor section of a split heat

pump, it is called a heat pump fan-coil air handler. For detailed information on heat pumps, see Chapters 9 and 48.

Electric forced-air furnaces are also used with packaged heat pumps and packaged air conditioners.

3. COMMERCIAL EQUIPMENT

The basic differences between residential and commercial furnaces are available options such as economizers, outdoor air dampers, and the type of electrical service required (three-phase).

Commercial heating equipment comes in almost as many flow arrangements and design variations as residential equipment. Some are identical to residential equipment, whereas others are unique to commercial applications. Some commercial units function as a part of a ducted system, and others operate as unducted space heaters.

Ducted Equipment

Upflow Gas-Fired Commercial Furnaces. These furnaces are normally incorporated into a system in conjunction with a commercial split-system air-conditioning unit and are available in either propane or natural gas. Oil-fired units may be available on a limited basis.

Horizontal Gas-Fired Duct Furnaces. Available for built-up light commercial systems, this type of furnace is not equipped with its own blower but is designed for uniform airflow across the entire furnace. Duct furnaces are normally certified for operation either upstream or downstream of an air conditioner cooling coil. If a combination blower and duct furnace is desired, a package called a blower unit heater is available. Duct furnaces and blower unit heaters are available in natural gas, propane, oil, and electric models.

Electric Duct Furnaces. These furnaces are available in a large range of sizes and are suitable for operation in upflow, downflow, or horizontal positions. These units are also used to supply auxiliary heat with the indoor section of a split heat pump.

Package Units. The most common commercial furnace is the package unit, sometimes known as a **rooftop unit (RTU)**. These are available as air-conditioning units with propane and natural gas furnaces, electric resistance heaters, or heat pumps. Combination oil-heat/electric-cool units are not commonly available.

Package units of 50 kW and under are available as single-zone units. The entire unit must be in either heating mode or cooling mode. All air delivered by the unit is at the same temperature. Frequently, the heating function is staged so that the system operates at reduced heat output when the load is small.

Large package units in the 50 to 175 kW range are available as single-zone units, as are small units; however, they are also available as multizone units. A multizone unit supplies conditioned air to several different zones of a building in response to individual thermostats controlling those zones. These units can supply heating to one or more zones at the same time that cooling is supplied to other zones.

Large package units are normally available only in a curbed configuration (i.e., units are mounted on a rooftop over a curbed opening in the roof). Supply and return air enters through the bottom of the unit. Smaller units may be available for either curbed or uncurbed mounting. In either case, the unit is usually connected to ductwork in the building to distribute the conditioned air.

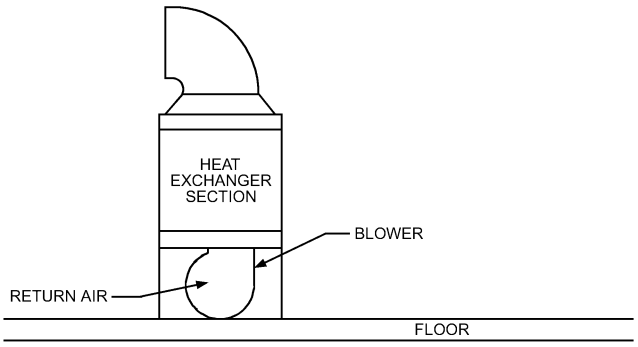

Fig. 8 Standing Floor Furnace

Unducted Heaters

Ductless furnaces, floor furnaces (Figure 8), and wall furnaces are discussed in Chapter 34. Infrared heating equipment is covered in Chapter 16.

4. CONTROLS AND OPERATING CHARACTERISTICS

External to Furnace

Externally, the furnace is controlled by a low-voltage room thermostat. Chapter 7 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* discusses thermostats in detail.

In North America, a furnace that is not part of a package unit is commonly installed with a split-system air conditioner. The furnace control receives input from the room thermostat, which determines the mode of operation. The furnace blower is used to circulate air through the ducts in the heating, cooling, and circulating modes of operation.

Internal to Furnace

Several types of gas valves perform various functions within the furnace. The type of valve available relates closely to the type of ignition device used. **Two-stage valves**, available on some furnaces, operate at full gas input or at a reduced rate, and are controlled by either a two-stage thermostat or a software algorithm programmed in the furnace control system. They provide less heat at the reduced input and, therefore, may produce less space temperature variation and greater comfort during mild weather conditions when full heat output is not required. Two-stage control is used frequently for zoning applications. Fuel savings with two-stage firing rate systems may not be realized unless both the fuel and the combustion air are controlled.

The **fan control switch** controls the circulating air blower. This switch may be temperature-sensitive and exposed to the circulating airstream in the furnace cabinet, or it may be an electronically operated relay. Blower start-up is typically delayed about 1 min after burner start-up. This delay gives the heat exchangers time to warm up and reduces the flow of cold air when the blower comes on. Blower shutdown is also delayed several minutes after burner shutdown to remove residual heat from the heat exchangers and to improve the annual efficiency of the furnace. Constant blower operation throughout the heating season is sometimes used to improve air circulation; however, this increases fan motor energy consumption, duct conductive losses, and air distribution system air leakage losses. Electronic motors that provide continuous but variable airflow use less energy. Both strategies may be considered when air filtering performance is important.

The **limit switch** prevents overheating in the event of severe reduction in circulating airflow. This temperature-sensitive switch is exposed to the circulating airstream and shuts off the heat source (e.g., gas valve or electric element) if the temperature of air leaving the furnace is excessive. The fan control and limit switches are sometimes incorporated in the same housing and may be operated by the same thermostatic element. In the United States, the **blocked-vent shutoff switch** and **flame rollout switch** have been required on residential furnaces produced since November 1989; they shut off the gas valve if the vent is blocked or when insufficient combustion air is present.

Furnaces using fan-assisted combustion feature a **pressure switch** to verify the flow of combustion air before opening the gas valve.

Electronic control systems are available in furnaces to provide sequencing of the inducer prepurge, ignition, circulating air blower operation, and inducer postpurge functions according to an algorithm provided by the manufacturer.

5. EQUIPMENT SELECTION

Many options are available to consumers, and careful planning is needed when selecting equipment. Some decisions can be very basic, whereas others may require research into the various kinds of equipment and features that are available. Several selection considerations are presented here.

Distribution System

A fundamental question in the selection process is whether the space to be heated uses a circulating forced-air system or a hydronic system. These two types of systems are vastly different with respect to equipment selection. For hydronic systems, refer to Chapter 36.

Forced-air systems vary widely. A forced-air distribution system typically has a central air duct, with branches feeding air to numerous supply registers. The duct branches are designed to proportion the air to the different spaces in the building, so that temperatures are best managed by a central thermostat location. Some systems are zoned, with different thermostat sensors; in these systems, dampers with electrical motors are placed at strategic branches of the distribution system and are opened or closed according to each zone's demand for heat. Choosing a zoned system affects the type of equipment selected. Chapter 10 discusses the overall design configuration and efficiency of forced-air systems.

Equipment Location

Furnaces can be installed inside or outside a building. For ideal air distribution, locate the unit in the center of the structure being heated. Furnaces are typically located in a closet, mechanical room, basement, attic, crawlspace, garage, or outdoors. As minimum efficiency levels have increased for residential air-conditioning systems, evaporator coils have increased in height to accommodate additional coil surface area. Compact furnaces have been introduced that allow the evaporator coil and furnace system combination to be installed as a replacement without structural modification in some cases. For installations that cannot be accommodated by the more compact furnace designs, the furnace and evaporator coil are more often located in attic or garage spaces.

Installation locations are characterized as either indoors, outdoors (weatherized), or isolated combustion systems (ICS). **Indoor** furnaces are installed in the heated structure, such as in a basement that is connected to the internal living space, in a utility room, or in a closet. In these locations, air that directly surrounds the furnace is in communication with the air of the heated space. Heat that is lost from the cabinet and adjacent ducts by conduction or air leakage is largely recaptured, helping to preserve furnace efficiency. Some furnaces use combustion air from inside the building. In these applications, room air is used for combustion and exhausted to the outdoors. Additionally, dilution air is also drawn from the room. Combustion/dilution makeup air is provided to the combustion appliance zone by infiltration or by a duct designed specifically to provide makeup air, as required by installation codes.

Furnaces located **outside** the conditioned space (e.g., crawlspace, attic, garage, outdoors) regain little or none of the conductive or air leakage energy losses. Outdoor installations require furnaces to be qualified as weatherized. Outdoor installation locations are on rooftops, platforms, or on a pad adjacent to the heated structure. Ducts for supply and return air connections may also be exposed to the elements and should be weatherized appropriately or moved inside to the conditioned space.

Isolated combustion systems (ICS) are within the structure being heated, but the air that directly surrounds the furnace does not communicate with the heated space. Air needed for combustion and ventilation is admitted through grille openings or ducts (NFPA *Standard* 54). Heat given off from the casing is not considered usable heat, and is subtracted from the furnace efficiency. Typical ICS locations include garages, attics, crawlspaces, and closets that are directly ventilated to the outdoors. These furnaces are protected from the elements (but not temperature) by the surrounding structure.

Forced-Air System Primary Use

Forced-air systems have many benefits, the most significant of which is that they can be used for both heating and cooling without needing separate duct systems and separate air-handling units. A primary function of the furnace is to circulate air through the forced-air distribution system.

Heating the air is an inherent function of a furnace. Cooling is typically a modular add-on, although some furnaces are included as a part of a packaged furnace-and-air-conditioner combination appliance. Forced-air systems also make it possible to add humidifiers and air filters or purifiers. In some cases, forced-air systems can also be connected to an additional appliance to bring clean air from the outdoors through air-to-air energy recovery heat exchangers. Proposed central-fan-integrated ventilation systems would use the furnace blower to pull in and distribute a controlled amount of outdoor air.

Air distribution system design must take into account all the system's intended functions. The air-handling capacity must be designed to meet the demand of the highest airflow and static pressure needs. Typically, the airflow needed for heating is less than that needed for cooling. Manufacturers provide information on furnace performance capabilities, including how much airflow it can deliver at different static pressures. Furnace specification data typically describe the gas input for heating and the airflow (or cooling capacity) for which the unit is designed.

Fuel Selection

The type of fuel selected for heating is based on relative fuel cost, number of heating degree-days, and availability of utilities in the area. The most common fuel is natural gas because of its clean burning characteristics, and because of the continuous supply of this fuel through underground distribution networks to most urban settings. Propane and oil fuels are also commonly used. These fuels require on-site storage and periodic fuel deliveries. Electric heat is also continuously available through electrical power grids and is common especially where natural gas is not provided, or where the heating demand is small relative to the cooling demand.

Furnaces are clearly marked for the type of fuel to be used. In some cases, a manufacturer-approved conversion kit may be necessary to convert a furnace from one fuel type to another. If the fuel type is changed after the original installation, the conversion must be done by a qualified service person per the manufacturer's instructions and using the manufacturer's specified conversion kit. After conversion, the unit must be properly inspected by the local code authority.

Combustion Air and Venting

All fuel-burning furnaces must be properly vented to the outdoors. Metal vents, masonry chimneys, and plastic vents are commonly used for furnaces. Manufacturers provide installation instructions for venting their furnaces, and Chapter 35 has a detailed discussion on venting.

Air for combustion enters the combustion zone through louvers or pipes. Outdoor air usually has lower levels of pollutants than are

typically found in air from indoors, garages, utility rooms, and basements. If the furnace is not exposed to pollutants, the heat exchanger material will have a long life.

Equipment Sizing

The furnace's heating capacity (i.e., the maximum heating rate the furnace can provide) is provided on the appliance rating plate; it is also available through the Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute directories (AHRI 2016) and manufacturers' product literature. The heating load for the intended space must be determined; variables that must be considered when calculating space load include heat gains or losses through walls, floors, and ceiling; infiltration; fenestration; ventilation; internal loads; and humidification. Chapters 17 to 19 in the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* provide the information necessary to determine residential and nonresidential heating loads.

Other factors should be considered when determining furnace capacity. Thermostat setback recovery may require additional heating capacity. On the other hand, supplemental heat sources or off-peak storage devices may offset some of the peak demand capacity. Increasing furnace capacity may increase space temperature swing, and thus reduce comfort. Two-stage or step-modulating equipment could help by using the unit's maximum capacity to meet the setback recovery needs, and providing a lower stage of heating capacity at other times.

If cooling is included, the cooling load must be considered, especially in climates that have substantial cooling loads but minimal heating loads. When a large cooling load necessitates a large airflow rate, heating capacity may be greater than necessary. Two-stage or modulating heating may be a suitable alternative to reduce the potentially large temperature swings that can occur with excessively oversized furnaces.

Types of Furnaces

Fuel-burning furnaces are typically subdivided into two primary categories: noncondensing and condensing. **Condensing** furnaces typically have high efficiencies, ranging from 89 to 98%, because they have a specially designed secondary heat exchanger that extracts the heat of vaporization of water vapor in the exhaust. Such heat exchangers may collect soot in small passages if the burners are not set up properly for the heating value of the gas used. The dew-point temperatures of flue gases of condensing furnaces are significantly above the vent temperature, so plastic or other corrosion-resistant venting material is required. Condensing furnaces must be plumbed for condensate disposal. Provisions must be taken to prevent the condensate trap and drain line from freezing if installed in a location that is likely to be below freezing at some point in the year.

Noncondensing furnaces have generally less than 82% steady-state efficiency. This type of furnace has higher flue gas temperatures and requires either metal, masonry, or a combination of the two for venting materials. Because there is no water management, noncondensing furnaces do not need freeze protection.

Consumer Considerations

Safety and Reliability. Gas furnaces sold in North America are tested and certified to ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA 2.3 requirements. Oil furnaces are tested in accordance with UL *Standard* 727, and oil burners in accordance with UL *Standard* 296. These standards are intended to ensure that consumer safety and product reliability are maintained in appliance design. Because of open-flame combustion, the following safety items need to be considered: (1) the surrounding atmosphere should be free of dust or chemical concentrations; (2) a path for combustion air must be provided for both sealed and open combustion chambers; and (3) the gas piping and vent pipes must be installed according to the NFPA/AGA *National Fuel Gas Code* (NFPA *Standard* 54), local codes, and the manufacturer's instructions. For electric furnaces, safety primarily concerns proper wiring techniques. Wiring should comply with the *National Electrical Code*® (NEC) (NFPA *Standard* 70) and applicable local codes.

Efficiency, Operating, and Life-Cycle Costs. Annual operating costs of furnaces must take into account both the cost of the heating fuel as well as the electrical efficiency of the blower motor. Life-cycle cost determination includes initial cost, maintenance, energy consumption, design life, and price escalation of the fuel. Annual fuel utilization efficiency (AFUE) and energy consumption data to help calculate the annual cost for heating a building are available in the AHRI (2016) directory. AFUE and fuel cost are primary drivers in the operating cost. Electric furnaces are listed as nearly 100% AFUE (site-based) because all of the electrical energy is converted into heat, and the only inefficiency is from cabinet conduction and air leakage losses.

Cabinet leakage can affect energy consumption and indoor air quality when furnaces are installed outside the conditioned living space, especially when the home and distribution system are otherwise of tight construction. Air leakage should be taken into account during system design and location. Care should also be taken to install equipment according to the manufacturer's instructions, and that gaps are not overlooked by the installer where service entries or attachments are made to the cabinet. The *ENERGY STAR*® qualification specifications for furnaces require that cabinet leakage be less than or equal to 2% of the maximum airflow, measured according to ANSI/ASHRAE *Standard* 193-2010.

Design Life. Typically, heat exchangers made of aluminized steel have a design life of approximately 15 years. Some furnaces now have a 20 year warranty, or even a "lifetime" warranty on the heat exchanger.

The design life of electric furnaces depends on the durability of the contactors and heating elements. The typical design life is approximately 15 years.

Comfort. Consumer opinions of comfort vary quite a bit. Thermal comfort is affected by supply air temperature, air velocity leaving the supply registers, and proximity of the supply airflow stream to occupants. Complaints of draftiness are common when delivered supply air temperatures are low and register velocities are high. A common solution is to reduce the blower speed to get more temperature rise, while staying within the rated temperature rise range listed on the rating plate. However, reducing blower speed can lead to distribution problems. System design, including register selection and placement, should take these issues into account to avoid comfort problems.

Large temperature swings may also cause discomfort. Factors that affect temperature swing include oversizing, thermostat cycling characteristics related to the number of cycles per hour, and thermostatic control. Two-stage or step-modulated heating can improve comfort by reducing the wide, variable temperature swings. These control schemes reduce furnace capacity through gas and blower modulation, which reduces the amount of oversizing for the current demand.

Comfort can also be affected by the indoor air quality. Adding air filters with high minimum efficiency reporting value (MERV; see ASHRAE *Standard* 52.2) ratings reduces airborne particulate matter and allergens. Winter months typically cause drier indoor air conditions, which can be offset by adding duct-integrated humidifiers. Both filters and humidifiers affect duct resistance, which in turn affects electrical energy consumption, and therefore must be considered in system design.

Sound level can be classified as a comfort consideration. Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* outlines procedures for determining acceptable noise levels.

Many options are available to increase comfort or economy. To manage comfort and cost of operation, a fuel-burning furnace can be combined with a heat pump; this takes advantage of the heat pump's relatively high efficiency during mild weather, and switches to fuel heating when outdoor temperatures drop and it becomes more difficult for heat pumps to meet the demand. To reduce peak demand for energy, off-peak storage devices may be used to decrease the required capacity of the furnace. The storage device can supply the additional capacity required during the morning recovery of a night setback cycle or reduce the daily peak loads to help in load shedding. Detailed calculations can determine the contribution of storage devices.

Selecting Furnaces for Commercial Buildings

The procedure for design and selection of a commercial furnace is similar to that for a residential furnace. First, the design capacity of the heating system must be determined, considering heat loss from the structure, recovery load, internal heat sources, humidification, off-peak storage, waste heat recovery, and back-up capacity. Because most commercial buildings use setback during weekends, evenings, or other long periods of inactivity, the recovery load is important, as are internal loads and waste heat recovery. The furnace should be sized according to the load per ACCA (2004).

Efficiency of commercial units is about the same as for noncondensing residential units. Two-stage gas valves are frequently used with commercial furnaces, but the efficiency of a two-stage system may be lower than for a single-stage system. At a reduced firing rate, excess combustion airflow through the burners increases, decreasing the steady-state operating efficiency of the furnace. Multistage furnaces with multistage thermostats and controls may be used to more appropriately match load conditions.

The design life of commercial heating and cooling equipment is about 20 years. Most gas furnace heat exchangers are either coated steel or stainless steel. Because most commercial furnaces are made for outdoor application, the cabinets are made from corrosion-resistant coated steel (e.g., galvanized or aluminized). Blowers can be direct- or belt-driven and can deliver air at higher static pressure.

The noise level of commercial heating equipment is important in some applications, such as schools, office buildings, churches, and theaters. Unit heaters, for example, are used primarily in industrial applications where noise is less important. Duct design can greatly affect noise levels.

In many jurisdictions, safety requirements are the same for light commercial systems and residential systems. Above 117 kW gas input, ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA 2.3 requirements for gas controls are more stringent.

6. CALCULATIONS

Performance Criteria. Residential furnaces and boilers manufactured and distributed in commerce, as defined by 42 U.S.C. 6291 (16), must meet the energy conservation standards specified in the *Code of Federal Regulations*, 10 CFR 430.32(e)(1)(i) and (e)(2)(i). This information is also available in the Electronic Code of Federal Regulations, and is published in the AHRI (2016) directories. To calculate the furnace's rated heating capacity, the steady-state efficiency must be determined. In the United States, manufacturers may publish only the AFUE as an efficiency measure. The unit capacity is proportional to the steady-state efficiency when compared to the fuel input rate.

U.S. federal law requires manufacturers of furnaces to use AFUE as determined using the isolated combustion system method to rate efficiency. Since January 1, 1992, all furnaces produced have a minimum AFUE (ICS) level of 78%. Table 1 gives efficiency values for different furnaces.

Table 1 Historical and Typical Values of Efficiency

	AFUE, %	
Type of Gas Furnace	**Indoor**	**ICS[a]**
1. Natural-draft with standing pilot	64.5	63.9[b]
2. Natural-draft with intermittent ignition	69.0	68.5[b]
3. Natural-draft with intermittent ignition and auto vent damper	78.0	68.5[b]
4. Fan-assisted combustion with standing pilot or intermittent ignition	80.0	78.0
5. Same as 4, except with improved heat transfer	82.0	80.0
6. Direct vent, natural-draft with standing pilot, preheat	66.0	64.5[b]
7. Direct vent, fan-assisted combustion, and intermittent ignition	80.0	78.0
8. Fan-assisted combustion (induced-draft)	80.0	78.0
9. Condensing	90.0	88.0
Type of Oil Furnace	**Indoor**	**ICS[a]**
1. Standard: pre-1992	71.0	69.0[b]
2. Standard: post-1992	80.0	78.0
3. Same as 2, with improved heat transfer	81.0	79.0
4. Same as 3, with automatic vent damper	82.0	80.0
5. Condensing	91.0	89.0

[a]Isolated combustion system (estimate).
[b]Pre-1992 design (pilot lights and natural draft systems are now obsolete).

7. TECHNICAL DATA

Detailed technical data on furnaces are available from manufacturers, wholesalers, and dealers. The data are generally tabulated in product specification bulletins printed by the manufacturer for each furnace line. These bulletins usually include performance information, electrical data, blower and air delivery data, control system information, optional equipment information, and dimensions.

Natural Gas Furnaces

Capacity Ratings. ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA 2.3 requires that the heating capacity be marked on the rating plates of commercial furnaces in the United States. The heating capacity of residential furnaces, less than 65 kW input, is required by the Federal Trade Commission and can be found in furnace directories provided by AHRI at www.ahridirectory.org. Capacity is calculated by multiplying the input by the steady-state efficiency.

Residential gas furnaces with heating capacities ranging from 10 to 50 kW are readily available. Some smaller furnaces are manufactured for special-purpose installations such as mobile homes. Smaller-capacity furnaces are becoming common because new homes are better insulated and have lower heat loads than older homes. Larger furnaces are also available, but these are generally considered for commercial use.

Because of the overwhelming popularity of the upflow furnace, or multiposition including upflow, it is available in the greatest number of models and sizes. Downflow furnaces, dedicated horizontal furnaces, and various combinations are also available but are generally limited in model type and size.

Residential gas furnaces can be installed as heating-only systems or as part of a heat/cool system. The difference is that, in the heat/cool system, the furnace operates as the air-handling section of a split-system air conditioner. Heating-only systems typically operate with enough airflow to yield a 22 to 40 K air temperature rise through the furnace. Condensing furnaces may be designed for a lower temperature rise (as low as 20 K).

Furnaces have blowers capable of multiple speeds. When the furnace is used as the air handler for a cooling system, the blower is typically capable of delivering about 55 L/s per kilowatt of air conditioning. Furnaces are generally available to accommodate 5 to 18 kW air conditioners. The blower speed for each mode of opera-

tion should be selected to provide the required airflow for both heating and cooling operation. Controls of furnaces used in a heat/cool system can be installed to operated the multispeed blower motor at the most appropriate speed for either heating or cooling when airflow requirements vary for each mode.

Efficiency Ratings. Currently, gas furnaces have steady-state efficiencies that vary from about 78 to 98%. Natural-draft and fan-assisted combustion furnaces typically range from 78 to 80% efficiency, whereas condensing furnaces have over 90% steady-state efficiency.

Propane Furnaces

Most residential natural gas furnaces are also available in a propane version with identical ratings. The technical data for these two furnaces are identical, except for gas control and burner and pilot orifice sizes. Orifice sizes on propane furnaces are much smaller because propane has a higher density and may be supplied at a higher manifold pressure. The heating value and relative density of typical gases are listed as follows:

Gas Type	Heating Value, MJ/m^3	Relative Density (Air = 1.0)
Natural	38.4	0.60
Propane	93.1	1.53
Butane	118.3	2.00

As in natural gas furnaces, the ignition systems have a required pilot gas shutoff feature in case the pilot ignition fails. Pilot gas leakage is more critical with propane or butane gas because both are heavier than air and can accumulate to create an explosive mixture in the furnace or furnace enclosure.

Besides natural and propane, a furnace may be certified for manufactured gas, mixed gas, or propane/air mixtures; however, furnaces with these certifications are not commonly available. Mobile home furnaces are certified as convertible from natural gas to propane.

Oil Furnaces

Oil furnaces are similar to gas furnaces in size, shape, and function, but the heat exchanger, burner, and combustion control are significantly different.

Input ratings are based on oil flow rate (L/s), and heating capacity is calculated by the same method as that for gas furnaces. The typical heating value of oil is 39 MJ/L. Fewer models and sizes are available for oil than are available for gas, but residential furnaces in the range of 19 to 44 kW heating capacity are common. Air delivery ratings are similar to gas furnaces.

The efficiency of an oil furnace can drop during normal operation if the burner is not maintained and kept clean. In this case, the oil does not atomize sufficiently to allow complete combustion, and energy is lost up the chimney in the form of unburned hydrocarbons. Because most oil furnaces use power burners and electric ignition, the annual efficiency is relatively high.

Oil furnaces are available in upflow, downflow, and horizontal models. The thermostat, fan control switch, and limit switch are similar to those of a gas furnace. Oil flow is controlled by a pump and burner nozzle, which sprays the oil/air mixture into a single-chamber drum-type heat exchanger. The heat exchangers are normally heavy-gage cold-rolled steel. Humidifiers, electronic air cleaners, and night setback thermostats are available as accessories.

Electric Furnaces

Residential electric resistance furnaces are available in heating capacities of 5 to 35 kW. Electric resistance furnaces are typically part of a heat/cool system and provide the appropriate airflow for both heating and cooling modes.

The only losses associated with an electric resistance furnace are the conductive and air leakage losses in the cabinet. If the furnace is located fully within the heated space, then the seasonal efficiency would be 100%.

Although the efficiency of an electric furnace is high, electricity is generally a relatively expensive form of energy. The operating cost may be reduced substantially by using an electric heat pump in place of a straight electric resistance furnace. Heat pump systems are discussed in Chapter 9.

Electric furnaces are available in upflow, downflow, or horizontal models. Internal controls include overload fuses or circuit breakers, overheat limit switches, a fan control switch, and contactors to bring on the heating elements at timed intervals.

Commercial Furnaces

Furnaces with capacities above 44 kW are classified as commercial furnaces. The 1992 U.S. Energy Policy and Conservation Act (EPCA) prescribes minimum efficiency requirements for commercial furnaces based on ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1. Some efficiency improvement components, such as intermittent ignition devices, are common in commercial furnaces.

8. INSTALLATION

Installation requirements call for a forced-air heating system to meet three basic criteria: (1) the system must be safe, (2) it must provide comfort for the occupants of the conditioned space, and (3) it must be energy efficient. Location of equipment and ducts, materials selected for the distribution system, and installation practices all affect the total system efficiency. Conduction and air leakage losses can result in substantial energy and system performance degradation and deserve special attention. For maximum safety, comfort, and efficiency, proper treatment of distribution system air leakage is necessary. A few significant considerations for installing furnaces are discussed here; for additional issues, see Chapter 10.

Generally, the following three categories of installation guidelines must be followed to ensure the safe operation of a heating system: (1) the equipment manufacturer's installation instructions, (2) local installation code requirements, and (3) national installation code requirements. Local code requirements may or may not be available, but the other two are always available. Depending on the type of fuel being used, one of the following national code requirements apply in the United States:

- NFPA 54 (also AGA Z223.1) — *National Fuel Gas Code*
- NFPA 70 — *National Electrical Code®*
- NFPA 31 — *Standard for the Installation of Oil-Burning Equipment*

Comparable Canadian standards are

- CAN/CSA-B149.1 — *Natural Gas and Propane Installation Code*
- CSA C22.1 — *Canadian Electrical Code*
- CAN/CSA B139 — *Installation Code for Oil Burning Equipment*

An additional source is the *International Fuel Gas Code®* (IFGC®) (ICC 2015). These regulations provide complete information about construction materials, gas line sizes, flue pipe sizes, wiring sizes, and so forth.

Proper design of the air distribution system is necessary for both comfort and safety. Chapter 21 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, Chapter 1 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, and Chapter 10 of this volume provide information on the design of ductwork for forced-air heating systems. Forced-air furnaces provide design airflow at a static pressure as low as 30 Pa for a residential unit to above 250 Pa for a commercial unit. The air distribution system must handle the required volumetric flow rate within the pressure limits of the equipment. If the system is a combined heating/cooling installation, the air distribution system

must meet the cooling requirement because more air is required for cooling than for heating. It is also important to include the pressure drop of the cooling coil. The Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute (AHRI) maximum allowable pressure drop for residential cooling coils is 75 Pa.

Condensing furnaces generate a large amount of relatively low-temperature water. It is important that the exhaust vent be sloped so that water runs back into the furnace. All furnace condensate should go into a drain and not be discharged where it might freeze. If there is not a gravity path to a drain, an adequate-capacity condensate pump is required.

9. AGENCY LISTINGS

Construction and performance of furnaces are regulated by several agencies.

AHRI, in cooperation with its industry members, sponsors a certification program relating to gas- and oil-fired residential furnaces and boilers. This program uses an independent laboratory to verify commercial and residential furnace and boiler manufacturers' certified AFUEs and heating capacities, as determined by testing in accordance with the U.S. DOE's *Uniform Test Method for Measuring the Energy Consumption of Furnaces and Boilers* (Title II, 10 CFR 430, Subpart B, Appendix N). Gas and oil furnaces with input ratings less than 66 kW and gas and oil boilers with input ratings less than 88 kW are currently included in the program.

Also included in the program are the online consumers' directories, which identify certified products and list the input rating, certified heating capacity, and AFUE for each furnace. Participating manufacturers are entitled to use the AHRI certification symbol.

ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA 2.3 (CSA America is secretariat) gives minimum construction, safety, and performance requirements for gas furnaces. The CSA maintains laboratories to certify furnaces and operates a factory inspection service. Furnaces tested and found to be in compliance are listed in the CSA directory and carry the seals of certification. Underwriters Laboratories (UL) and other approved laboratories can also test and certify equipment in accordance with ANSI *Standard* Z21.47/CSA 2.3.

Gas furnaces may be certified for standard, alcove, closet, or outdoor installation. Standard installation requires clearance between the furnace and combustible material of at least 150 mm. Furnaces certified for alcove or closet installation can be installed with reduced clearance, as listed. Furnaces certified for either sidewall venting or outdoor installation must operate properly in a 50 km/h wind. Construction materials must be able to withstand natural elements without degradation of performance and structure. Horizontal furnaces are normally certified for installation on combustible floors and for attic installation and are so marked, in which case they may be installed with point or line contact between the jacket and combustible constructions. Upflow and downflow furnaces are normally certified for alcove or closet installation. Gas furnaces may be listed to burn natural gas, mixed gas, manufactured gas, propane, or propane/air mixtures. A furnace must be equipped and certified for the specific gas to be used because different burners and controls, as well as orifice changes, may be required.

Sometimes oil burners and control packages are sold separately; however, they are normally sold as part of the furnace package. Pressure-type or rotary burners should bear the Underwriters Laboratory label showing compliance with ANSI/UL *Standard* 296. In addition, the complete furnace should bear markings indicating compliance with UL *Standard* 727. Vaporizing burner furnaces should also be listed under UL *Standard* 727.

UL *Standard* 1995 gives requirements for the listing and labeling of electric furnaces and heat pumps.

The following list summarizes important standards issued by Underwriters Laboratories, the Canadian Gas Association, and the Canadian Standards Association that apply to space-heating equipment:

ANSI/ASHRAE 103	Method of Testing for Annual Fuel Utilization Efficiency of Residential Central Furnaces and Boilers
ANSI Z21.66/CGA 6.14	Automatic Vent Damper Devices for Use with Gas-Fired Appliances
ANSI Z83.4/CSA 3.7	Non-Recirculating Direct Gas-Fired Industrial Air Heaters
ANSI Z83.18	Recirculating Direct Gas-Fired Industrial Air Heaters
ANSI Z83.19/CSA 2.35	Gas-Fired High-Intensity Infrared Heaters
ANSI Z83.20/CSA 2.34	Gas-fired Low-Intensity Infrared Heaters
ANSI Z83.8/CGA 2.6	Gas Unit Heaters, Gas-Packaged Heaters, Gas Utility Heaters, and Gas-Fired Duct Furnaces
ANSI Z21.47/CSA 2.3	Gas-Fired Central Furnaces
ANSI/UL 296	Oil Burners
ANSI/UL 307A	Liquid Fuel-Burning Heating Appliances for Manufactured Homes and Recreational Vehicles
ASHRAE 90.1	Energy Standard for Buildings Except Low-Rise Residential Buildings
ICC	*International Fuel Gas Code*®
NFPA 70	*National Electrical Code*®
UL 307B	Gas-Burning Heating Appliances for Manufactured Homes and Recreational Vehicles
UL 727	Oil-Fired Central Furnaces
UL 1995/CSA C22.2 No. 236	Heating and Cooling Equipment
CGA 3.2	Industrial and Commercial Gas-Fired Package Furnaces
CSA B140.4	Oil-Fired Warm Air Furnaces

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CHAPTER 34

RESIDENTIAL IN-SPACE HEATING EQUIPMENT

GAS IN-SPACE HEATERS 34.1
Controls 34.2
Vent Connectors 34.3
Sizing Units 34.3
OIL AND KEROSENE IN-SPACE HEATERS 34.3
ELECTRIC IN-SPACE HEATERS 34.3
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SOLID-FUEL IN-SPACE HEATERS 34.4
Fireplaces 34.5
Stoves 34.5
GENERAL INSTALLATION PRACTICES 34.6

IN-SPACE heating equipment differs from central heating in that fuel is converted to heat in the space to be heated. In-space heaters may be either permanently installed or portable and may transfer heat by a combination of radiation, natural convection, and forced convection. The energy source may be liquid, solid, gaseous, or electric.

1. GAS IN-SPACE HEATERS

Room Heaters

A **vented circulator room heater** is a self-contained, freestanding, nonrecessed gas-burning appliance that furnishes warm air directly to the space in which it is installed, without ducting (Figure 1). It converts the energy in the fuel gas to convected and radiant heat without mixing flue gases and circulating heated air by transferring heat from flue gases to a heat exchanger surface.

A **vented radiant circulator** is equipped with high-temperature glass panels and radiating surfaces to increase radiant heat transfer. Separation of flue gases from circulating air must be maintained. Vented radiant circulators range from 3 to 22 kW.

Gravity-vented radiant circulators may also have a circulating air fan, but they perform satisfactorily with or without the fan. Fan-type vented radiant circulators are equipped with an integral circulating air fan, which is necessary for satisfactory performance.

Vented room heaters are connected to a vent, chimney, or single-wall metal pipe venting system engineered and constructed to develop a positive flow to the outdoor atmosphere. Room heaters should not be used in a room that has limited air exchange with adjacent spaces because combustion air is drawn from the space.

Unvented radiant or **convection heaters** range in size from 3 to 12 kW and can be freestanding units or wall-mounted, nonrecessed units of either the radiant or closed-front type. Unvented room heaters require an outdoor air intake. The size of the fresh air opening required is marked on the heater. To ensure adequate fresh air supply, unvented gas-heating equipment must, according to voluntary standards, include a device that shuts the heater off if the oxygen in the room becomes inadequate. Unvented room heaters may not be installed in hotels, motels, or rooms of institutions such as hospitals or nursing homes.

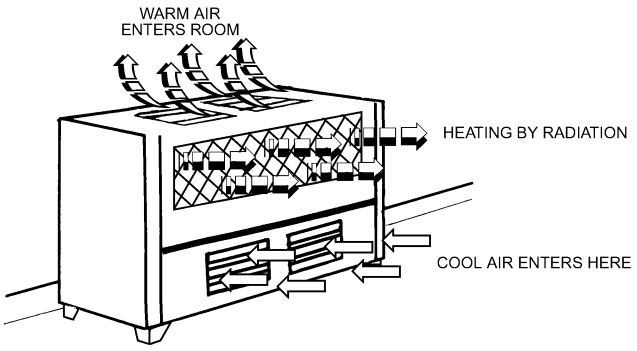

Fig. 1 Room Heater

Catalytic room heaters are fitted with fibrous material impregnated with a catalytic substance that accelerates the oxidation of a gaseous fuel to produce heat without flames. The design distributes the fuel throughout the fibrous material so that oxidation occurs on the surface area in the presence of a catalyst and room air. Catalytic heaters transfer heat by low-temperature radiation and by convection. The surface temperature is below a red heat and is generally below 650°C at the maximum fuel input rate. The flameless combustion of catalytic heaters is an inherent safety feature not offered by conventional flame-type gas-fueled burners. Catalytic heaters have also been used in agriculture and for industrial applications in combustible atmospheres.

Unvented household catalytic heaters are used in Europe. Most of these are portable and mounted on casters in a casing that includes a cylinder of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) so that they may be rolled from one room to another. LPG cylinders holding more than 0.9 kg of fuel are not permitted for indoor use in the United States. As a result, catalytic room heaters sold in the United States are generally permanently installed and fixed as wall-mounted units. Local codes and the *National Fuel Gas Code* (NFPA 54/ANSI Z223.1) should be reviewed for accepted combustion air requirements.

Wall Furnaces

A wall furnace is a self-contained vented appliance with grilles that are designed to be a permanent part of the structure of a building (Figure 2). It furnishes heated air that is circulated by natural or forced convection. A wall furnace can have boots, which may not extend more than 250 mm beyond the horizontal limits of the casing through walls of normal thickness, to provide heat to adjacent rooms. Wall furnaces range from 3 to 26 kW. Wall furnaces are classified as conventional or direct vent.

Conventional vent units require approved B-1 vent pipes and are installed to comply with the *National Fuel Gas Code*. Some wall furnaces are counterflow units that use fans to reverse the natural flow of air across the heat exchanger. Air enters at the top of the furnace and discharges at or near the floor. Counterflow systems reduce heat stratification in a room. As with any vented unit, a minimum of inlet air for proper combustion must be supplied.

Vented-recessed wall furnaces are recessed into the wall, with only the decorative grillwork extending into the room. This leaves more usable area in the room being heated. Dual-wall furnaces are two units that fit between the studs of adjacent rooms, thereby using a common vent.

Both vented-recessed and dual-wall furnaces are usually natural convection units. Cool room air enters at the bottom and is warmed

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.5, Radiant Heating and Cooling.

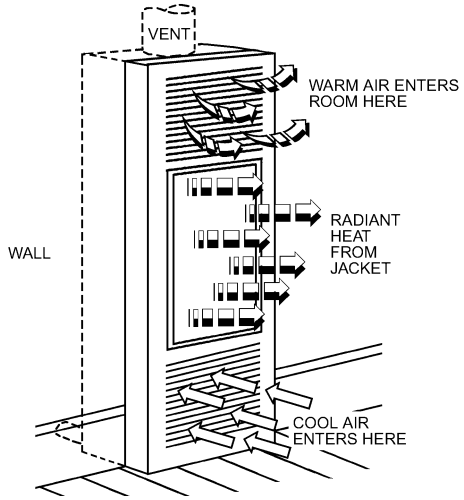

Fig. 2 Wall Furnace

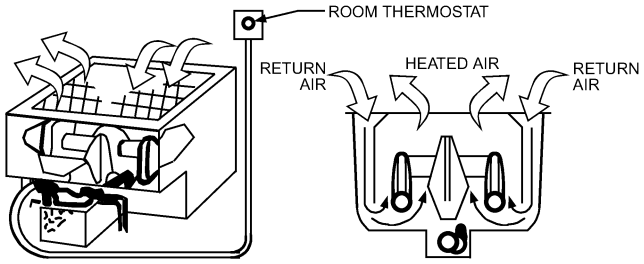

Fig. 3 Floor Furnace

as it passes over the heat exchanger, entering the room through the grillwork at the top of the heater. This process continues as long as the thermostat calls for the burners to be on. Accessory fans assist in the movement of air across the heat exchanger and help minimize air stratification.

Direct-vent wall furnaces are constructed so that combustion air comes from the outdoors, and all flue gases discharge into the outdoor atmosphere. These appliances include grilles or the equivalent and are designed to be attached to the structure permanently. Direct-vent wall heaters are normally mounted on walls with outdoor exposure.

Direct-vent wall furnaces can be used in extremely tight (well-insulated) rooms because combustion air is drawn from outside the room. There are no infiltration losses for dilution or combustion air. Most direct-vent heaters are designed for natural convection, although some may be equipped with fans. Direct-vent furnaces are available with inputs of 2 to 19 kW.

Floor Furnaces

Floor furnaces are self-contained units suspended from the floor of the heated space (Figure 3). Combustion air is taken from the outdoors, and flue gases are also vented outdoors. Cold air returns at the periphery of the floor register, and warm air comes up to the room through the center of the register.

U.S. Minimum Efficiency Requirements

The National Appliance Energy Conservation Act (NAECA) of 1987 mandates that the U.S. Department of Energy establish minimum annual fuel utilization efficiency (AFUE) requirements for gas-fired direct heating equipment. The first minimums were established on January 1, 1990, and were most recently updated on April 16, 2013 (Table 1).The AFUE is measured using the U.S. Department of Energy test method (DOE 2015) and must be met by manufacturers of direct heating equipment (i.e., gas-fired room heaters, wall furnaces, and floor furnaces).

Table 1 Efficiency Requirements in the United States for Gas-Fired Direct Heating Equipment

Input, kW	Minimum AFUE, %	Input, kW	Minimum AFUE, %
Wall Furnace (with fan)		*Floor Furnace*	
≤12.3	75	≤10.8	57
>12.3	76	>10.8	58
Wall Furnace (gravity type)			
≤7.9	65	*Room Heaters*	
>7.9 to 13.5	66	≤5.9	61
>13.5	67	>5.9 to 7.9	66
		>7.9 to 13	67
		>13.5	68

1.1 CONTROLS

Valves

Gas in-space heaters are controlled by four types of valves:

The full on/off, **single-stage valve** is controlled by a wall thermostat. Models are available that are powered by a 24 V supply or from energy supplied by the heat of the pilot light on the thermocouple (self-generating).

The **two-stage control valve** (with hydraulic thermostat) fires either at full input (100% of rating) or at some reduced step, which can be as low as 20% of the heating rate. The amount of time at the reduced firing rate depends on the heating load and the relative oversizing of the heater.

The **step-modulating control valve** (with a hydraulic thermostat) steps on to a low fire and then either cycles off and on at the low fire (if the heating load is light) or gradually increases its heat output to meet any higher heating load that cannot be met with the low firing rate. This control allows an infinite number of fuel firing rates between low and high fire.

The **manual control valve** is controlled by the user rather than by a thermostat. The user adjusts the fuel flow and thus the level of fire to suit heating requirements.

Thermostats

Temperature controls for gas in-space heaters are of the following two types.

- **Wall thermostats** are available in 24 V and millivolt systems. The 24 V unit requires an external power source and a 24 V transformer. Wall thermostats respond to temperature changes and turn the automatic valve to either full-on or full-off. The millivolt unit requires no external power because the power is generated by multiple thermocouples and may be either 250 or 750 mV, depending on the distance to the thermostat. This thermostat also turns the automatic valve to either full-on or full-off.
- **Built-in hydraulic thermostats** are available in two types: (1) a snap-action unit with a liquid-filled capillary tube that responds to changes in temperature and turns the valve to either full-on or full-off; and (2) a modulating thermostat, which is similar to the snap-action unit, except that the valve comes on and shuts off at a preset minimum input. Temperature alters the input anywhere from full-on to the minimum input. When the heating requirements are satisfied, the unit shuts off.

Table 2 Gas Input Required for In-Space Supplemental Heaters

Heater Type	Average AFUE, %	Steady State Efficiency, %	Gas Consumption per Unit House Volume, W/m³					
			Outdoor Air Temperature, °C					
			Older Bungalow[a]			Energy-Efficient House[b]		
			–15	0	10	–15	0	10
Vented	54.6	73.1	67.1	36.9	16.8	28.6	15.7	7.1
Unvented	90.5	90.5	61.7	33.9	15.4	26.3	14.4	6.6
Direct vent	76.0	78.2	60.7	33.4	15.2	21.1	11.6	5.3

[a]Tested bungalow total heated volume = 193.3 m³ and $U \approx 1.7$ to 2.8 W/(m²·K).
[b]Tested energy-efficient house total heated volume = 333.7 m³ and $U \approx 1.1$ to 1.7 W/(m²·K).

1.2 VENT CONNECTORS

Any vented gas-fired appliance must be installed correctly to vent combustion products. A detailed description of proper venting techniques is found in the *National Fuel Gas Code* and Chapter 35.

1.3 SIZING UNITS

The size of the unit selected depends on the size of the room, the number and direction of exposures, the amount of insulation in the ceilings and walls, and the geographical location. Heat loss requirements can be calculated from procedures described in Chapter 17 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

DeWerth and Loria (1989) studied the use of gas-fired, in-space supplemental heaters in two test houses. They proposed a heater sizing guide, which is summarized in Table 2. The energy consumption in Table 2 is for unvented, vented, and direct vent heaters installed in (1) a bungalow built in the 1950s with average insulation, and (2) a townhouse built in 1984 with above-average insulation and tightness.

2. OIL AND KEROSENE IN-SPACE HEATERS

Vaporizing Oil Pot Heaters

These heaters have an oil-vaporizing bowl (or other receptacle) that admits liquid fuel and air in controllable quantities; the fuel is vaporized by the heat of combustion and mixed with the air in appropriate proportions. Combustion air may be induced by natural draft or forced into the vaporizing bowl by a fan. Indoor air is generally used for combustion and draft dilution. Window-installed units have the burner section outdoors. Both natural- and forced-convection heating units are available. A small blower is sold as an option on some models. The heat exchanger, usually cylindrical, is made of steel (Figure 4). These heaters are available as room units (both radiant and circulation), floor furnaces, and recessed wall heaters. They may also be installed in a window, depending on the cabinet construction. The heater is always vented to the outdoors. An 11 to 19 L fuel tank may be attached to the heater, or a larger outdoor tank can be used.

Vaporizing pot burners are equipped with a single constant-level and metering valve. Fuel flows by gravity to the burner through the adjustable metering valve. Control can be manual, with an off pilot and variable settings up to maximum, or it can be thermostatically controlled, with the burner operating at a selected firing rate between pilot and high.

Powered Atomizing Heaters

Wall furnaces, floor furnaces, and freestanding room heaters are also available with a powered gun-type burner using No. 1 or No. 2 fuel oil. For more information, refer to Chapter 31.

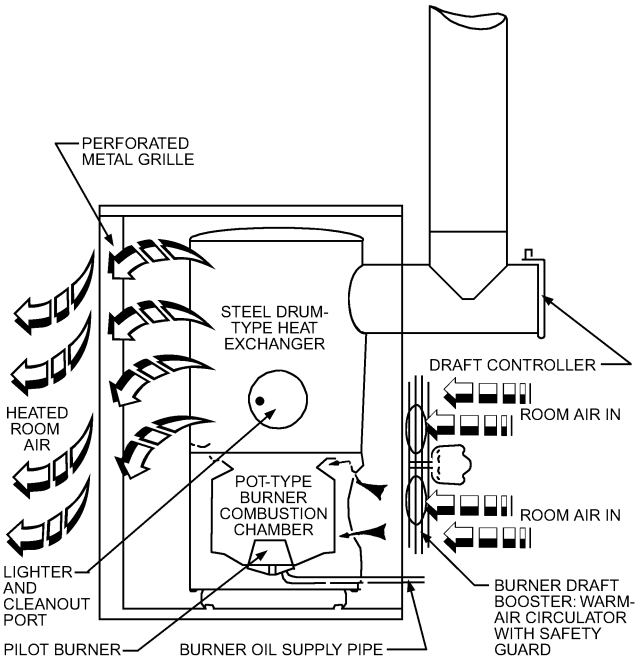

Fig. 4 Oil-Fueled Heater with Vaporizing Pot-Type Burner

Portable Kerosene Heaters

Because kerosene heaters are not normally vented, precautions must be taken to provide sufficient ventilation. Kerosene heaters are of four basic types: radiant, natural-convection, direct-fired, forced-convection, and catalytic.

The radiant kerosene heater has a reflector, while the natural convection heater is cylindrical in shape. Fuel vaporizes from the surface of a wick, which is immersed in an integral fuel tank of up to 7.6 L capacity similar to that of a kerosene lamp. Fuel-burning rates range from about 1.5 to 6.5 kW. Radiant heaters usually have a removable fuel tank to facilitate refueling.

The direct-fired, forced-convection portable kerosene heater has a vaporizing burner and a heat-circulating fan. These heaters are available with thermostatic control and variable heat output.

The catalytic type uses a metal catalyst to oxidize the fuel. It is started by lighting kerosene at the surface; however, after a few moments, the catalyst surface heats to the point that flameless oxidation of the fuel begins.

3. ELECTRIC IN-SPACE HEATERS

Wall, Floor, Toe Space, and Ceiling Heaters

Heaters for recessed or surface wall mounting are made with open wire or enclosed, metal-sheathed elements. An inner liner or reflector is usually placed between the elements and the casing to promote circulation and minimize the rear casing temperature. Heat is distributed by both convection and radiation; the proportion of each depends on unit construction.

Ratings are usually 1000 to 5000 W at 120, 208, 240, or 277 V. Models with air circulation fans are available. Other types can be recessed into the floor. Electric convectors should be placed so that air moves freely across the elements.

Baseboard Heaters

These heaters consist of a metal cabinet containing one or more horizontal, enclosed, metal-sheathed elements. The cabinet is less than 150 mm in overall depth and can be installed 460 mm above the

floor; the ratio of the overall length to the overall height is more than two to one.

Units are available from 610 to 3700 mm in length, with ratings from 300 to 1300 W/m, and they fit together to make up any desired continuous length or rating. Electric hydronic baseboard heaters containing immersion heating elements and an antifreeze solution are made with ratings of 300 to 2000 W. The placement of any type of electric baseboard heater follows the same principles that apply to baseboard installations (see Chapter 36) because baseboard heating is primarily perimeter heating.

3.1 RADIANT HEATING SYSTEMS

Heating Panels and Heating Panel Sets

These systems have electric resistance wire or etched or graphite elements embedded between two layers of insulation. High-density thermal insulation behind the element minimizes heat loss, and the outer shell is formed steel with baked enamel finish. Heating panels provide supplementary heating by convection and radiation. They can be recessed into or surface mounted on hard surfaces or fit in standard T-bar suspended ceilings.

Units are usually rated between 250 and 1000 W in sizes varying from 610 by 610 mm to 610 by 2440 mm in standard voltages of 120, 208, 240, and 277 V.

Embedded Cable and Storage Heating Systems

Ceiling and floor electric radiant heating systems that incorporate embedded cables are covered in Chapter 6. Electric storage systems, including room storage heaters and floor slab systems, are covered in Chapter 50.

Cord-Connected Portable Heaters

Portable electric heaters are often used in areas that are not accessible to central heat. They are also used to maintain an occupied room at a comfortable level independent of the rest of the residence.

Portable electric heaters for connection to 120 V, 15 A outlets are available with outputs of 600 to 1500 W, the most common being 1320 and 1500 W. Many heaters are available with a selector switch for three wattages (e.g., 1100-1250-1500 W). Heavy-duty heaters are usually connected to 240 V, 20 A outlets with outputs up to 4000 W, whereas those for connection to 240 V, 30 A outlets have outputs up to 5600 W. All electric heaters of the same wattage produce the same amount of heat.

Portable electric heaters transfer heat by one of two predominant methods: radiation and convection. Radiant heaters provide heat for people or objects. An element in front of a reflector radiates heat outward in a direct line. Conventional radiant heaters have ribbon or wire elements. Quartz radiant heaters have coil wire elements encased in quartz tubes. The temperature of a radiant wire element usually ranges between 650 and 870°C.

Convection heaters warm the air in rooms or zones. Air flows directly over the hot elements and mixes with room air. Convection heaters are available with or without fans. The temperature of a convection element is usually less than 500°C.

An adjustable, built-in bimetal thermostat usually controls the power to portable electric heaters. Fan-forced heaters usually provide better temperature control because the fan, in addition to cooling the case, forces room air past the thermostat. One built-in control uses a thermistor to signal a solid logic circuit that adjusts wattage and fan speed. Most quartz heaters use an adjustable control that operates the heater for a percentage of total cycle time from 0 (off) to 100% (full-on).

Controls

Low-voltage and line-voltage thermostats with on-off operation are used to control in-space electric heaters. Low-voltage thermostats, operating at 30 V or less, control relays or contactors that carry the rated voltage and current load of the heaters. Because the control current load is small (usually less than 1 A), the small switch can be controlled by a highly responsive sensing element.

Line-voltage thermostats carry the full load of the heaters at rated voltage directly through their switch contacts. Most switches carry a listing by Underwriters Laboratories (UL) at 22 A (resistive), 277 V rating. Most electric in-space heating systems are controlled by remote wall-mounted thermostats, but many are available with integral or built-in line-voltage thermostats.

Most low-voltage and line-voltage thermostats use small internal heaters, either fixed or adjustable in heat output, that provide heat anticipation by energizing when the thermostat contacts close. The cycling rate of the thermostat is increased by the use of anticipation heaters, resulting in more accurate control of the space temperature.

Droop is an apparent shift or lowering of the control point and is associated with line-voltage thermostats. In these thermostats, switch heating caused by large currents can add materially to the amount of droop. Most line-voltage thermostats in residential use control room heaters of 3 kW (12.5 A at 240 V) or less. At this moderate load and with properly sized anticipation heaters, the droop experienced is acceptable. Cycling rates and droop characteristics have a significant effect on thermostat performance.

4. SOLID-FUEL IN-SPACE HEATERS

Most wood-burning and coal-burning devices, except central wood-burning furnaces and boilers, are classified as solid-fuel in-space heaters (see Table 3). An in-space heater can be either a fireplace or a stove.

Table 3 Solid-Fuel In-Space Heaters

Type*	Approximate Efficiency,* %	Features	Advantages	Disadvantages
Simple fireplaces, masonry or prefabricated	–10 to +10	Open front. Radiates heat in one direction only.	Aesthetic.	Low efficiency. Heats only small areas.
High-efficiency fireplaces	25 to 45	Freestanding or built-in with glass doors, grates, ducts, and blowers.	Aesthetic. More efficient. Heats larger areas. Long service life. Maximum safety.	Medium efficiency.
Box stoves	20 to 40	Radiates heat in all directions.	Low initial cost. Heats large areas.	Fire hard to control. Short life. Wastes fuel.
Airtight stoves	40 to 55	Radiates heat in all directions. Sealed seams, effective draft control.	Good efficiency. Long burn times, high heat output. Longer service life.	Can create creosote problems.
High-efficiency catalytic wood heaters	65 to 75	Radiates heat in all directions. Sealed seams, effective draft control.	Highest efficiency. Long burn times, high heat output. Long life.	Creosote problems. High purchase price.

*Product categories are general; product efficiencies are approximate.

4.1 FIREPLACES

Simple Fireplaces

Simple fireplaces, especially all-masonry and noncirculating metal built-in fireplaces, produce little useful heat. They lend atmosphere and a sense of coziness to a room. Freestanding fireplaces are slightly better heat producers. Simple fireplaces have an average efficiency of about 10%. In extreme cases, the chimney draws more heated air than the fire produces.

The addition of glass doors to the front of a fireplace has both a positive and a negative effect. The glass doors restrict the free flow of indoor heated air up the chimney, but at the same time they restrict the radiation of the heat from the fire into the room.

Factory-Built Fireplaces

A factory-built fireplace consists of a fire chamber, chimney, roof assembly, and other parts that are factory made and intended to be installed as a unit in the field. These fireplaces have fireboxes of refractory-lined metal rather than masonry. Factory-built fireplaces come in both radiant and heat-circulating designs. Typical configurations are open-front designs, but corner-opening, three-sided units with openings either on the front or side; four-sided units; and see-through fireplaces are also available.

Radiant Design. The radiant system transmits heat energy from the firebox opening by direct radiation to the space in front of it. These fireplaces may also incorporate such features as an outdoor air supply and glass doors. Radiant-design factory-built fireplaces are primarily used for aesthetic wood burning and typically have efficiencies similar to those of masonry fireplaces (0 to 10%).

Heat-Circulating Design. This unit transfers heat by circulating air around the fire chamber and releasing to the space to be heated. The air intake is generally below the firebox or low on the sides adjacent to the opening, and the heated air exits through grilles or louvers located above the firebox or high on the sides adjacent to it. In some designs, ducts direct heated air to spaces other than the area near the front of the fireplace. Some circulating units rely on natural convection, while others have electric fans or blowers to move air. These energy-saving features typically boosts efficiency 25 to 60%.

Freestanding Fireplaces

Freestanding fireplaces are open-combustion wood-burning appliances that are not built into a wall or chase. One type of freestanding fireplace is a fire pit in which the fire is open all around; smoke rises into a hood and then into a chimney. Another type is a prefabricated metal unit that has an opening on one side. Because they radiate heat to all sides, freestanding fireplaces are typically more efficient than radiant fireplaces.

4.2 STOVES

Conventional Wood Stoves

Wood stoves are chimney-connected, solid-fuel-burning room heaters designed to be operated with the fire chamber closed. They deliver heat directly to the space in which they are located. They are not designed to accept ducts and/or pipes for heat distribution to other spaces. Wood stoves are controlled-combustion appliances. Combustion air enters the firebox through a controllable air inlet; the air supply and thus the combustion rate are controlled by the user. Conventional controlled-combustion wood stoves manufactured before the mid-1980s typically have overall efficiencies ranging from 40 to 55%.

Most **controlled-combustion** appliances are constructed of steel, cast iron, or a combination of the two metals; others are constructed of soapstone or masonry. Soapstone and masonry have lower thermal conductivities but greater specific heats (the amount of heat that can be stored in a given mass). Other materials such as special refractories and ceramics are used in low-emission appliances. Wood stoves are classified as either radiant or convection (sometimes called circulating) heaters, depending on the way they heat interior spaces.

Radiant wood stoves are generally constructed with single exterior walls, which absorb radiant heat from the fire. This appliance heats primarily by infrared radiation; it heats room air only to the extent that air passes over the hot surface of the appliance.

Convection wood stoves have double vertical walls with an air space between the walls. The double walls are open at the top and bottom of the appliance to permit room air to circulate through the air space. The more buoyant hot air rises and draws in cooler room air at the bottom of the appliance. This air is then heated as it passes over the surface of the inner radiant wall. Some radiant heat from the inner wall is absorbed by the outer wall, but the constant introduction of room temperature air at the bottom of the appliance keeps the outer wall moderately cool. This characteristic generally allows convection wood stoves to be placed closer to combustible materials than radiant wood stoves. Fans in some wood stoves augment the movement of heated air. Convection wood stoves generally provide more even heat distribution than do radiant types.

Advanced-Design Wood Stoves

Strict air pollution standards have prompted the development of new stove designs. These clean-burning wood stoves use either catalytic or noncatalytic technology to achieve very high combustion efficiency and to reduce creosote and particulate and carbon monoxide emission levels.

Catalytic combustors are currently available as an integral part of many new wood-burning appliances and are also available as add-on or retrofit units for most existing appliances. The catalyst may be platinum, palladium, rhodium, or a combination of these elements. It is bonded to a ceramic or stainless steel substrate. A catalytic combustor's function in a wood-burning appliance is to substantially lower the ignition temperatures of unburned gases, solids, and/or liquid droplets (from approximately 540°C to 260°C). As these unburned combustibles leave the main combustion chamber and pass through the catalytic combustor, they ignite and burn rather than enter the atmosphere.

For the combustor to efficiently burn the gases, the proper amount of oxygen and a sufficient temperature to maintain ignition are required; further, the gases must have sufficient residence time in the combustor. A properly operating catalytic combustor has a temperature in the range of 540 to 930°C. Catalyst-equipped wood stoves have a default efficiency, as determined by the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), of 72%, although many stoves are considerably more efficient. This EPA default efficiency is the value one standard deviation below the mean of the efficiencies from a database of stoves.

Another approach to increasing combustion efficiency and meeting emissions requirements is the use of technologically advanced internal appliance designs and materials. Generally, noncatalytic, low-emission wood-burning appliances incorporate high-temperature refractory materials and have smaller fireboxes than conventional appliances. The fire chamber is designed to increase temperature, turbulence, and residence time in the primary combustion zone. Secondary air is introduced to promote continued burning of the gases, solids, and liquid vapors in a secondary combustion zone. Many stoves add a third and fourth burn area within the firebox. The location and design of the air inlets is critical because proper air circulation patterns are the key to approaching complete combustion. Noncatalytic wood stoves have an EPA default efficiency of 63%; however, many models approach 80%.

Fireplace Inserts

Fireplace inserts are closed-combustion wood-burning room heaters that are designed to be installed in an existing masonry fireplace. They combine elements of both radiant and convection wood stove designs. They have large radiant surfaces that face the room and circulating jackets on the sides that capture heat that would otherwise go up the chimney. Inserts may use either catalytic or noncatalytic technology to achieve clean burning.

Pellet-Burning Stoves

Pellet-burning stoves burn small pellets made from wood byproducts rather than burning logs. An electric auger feeds the pellets from a hopper into the fire chamber, where air is blown through, creating very high temperatures in the firebox. The fire burns at such a high temperature that the smoke is literally burned up, resulting in a very clean burn, and no chimney is needed. Instead, the waste gases are exhausted to the outdoors through a vent. An air intake is operated by an electric motor; another small electric fan blows the heated air from the area around the fire chamber into the room. A microprocessor controls the operation, allowing the pellet-burning stove to be controlled by a thermostat. Pellet-burning stoves typically have the lowest emissions of all wood-burning appliances and have an EPA default efficiency of 78%. Because of the high air/fuel ratios used by pellet-burning stoves, these stoves are excluded from EPA wood stove emissions regulations.

5. GENERAL INSTALLATION PRACTICES

The criteria to ensure safe operation are normally covered by local codes and ordinances or, in rare instances, by state and federal requirements. Most codes, ordinances, or regulations refer to the following building codes and standards for in-space heating:

Building Codes	
BOCA/National Building Code	BOCA
CABO One- and Two-Family Dwelling Code	CABO
International Building Code	ICC
National Building Code of Canada	NBCC
Standard Building Code	SBCCI
Uniform Building Code	ICBO
Mechanical Codes	
National Mechanical Code	BOCA
Uniform Mechanical Code	IAPMO
International Mechanical Code	ICC
Standard Mechanical Code	SBCCI
Electrical Codes	
National Electrical Code	NFPA 70
Canadian Electrical Code	CSA C22.1
Chimneys	
Chimneys, Fireplaces, Vents and Solid Fuel-Burning Appliances	NFPA 211
Chimneys, Factory-Built Residential Type and Building Heating Appliance	UL 103
Solid-Fuel Appliances	
Factory-Built Fireplaces	UL 127
Room Heaters, Solid-Fuel Type	UL 1482

Chapter 51 has further information, including the names and addresses of these agencies. Safety and performance criteria are furnished by these agencies.

Table 4 Chimney Connector Wall Thickness*

Diameter	Gage	Minimum Thickness, mm
Less than 152 mm	26	0.48
152 mm to 254 mm	24	0.58
254 mm to 406 mm	22	0.74
406 mm or greater	16	1.42

*Do not use thinner connector pipe. Replace connectors as necessary. Leave at least 460 mm clearance between the connector and a wall or ceiling, unless the connector is listed for a smaller clearance or an approved clearance reduction system is used.

Safety with Solid Fuels

The evacuation of combustion gases is a prime concern in the installation of solid-fuel-burning equipment. NFPA *Standard* 211, Chimneys, Fireplaces, Vents and Solid Fuel-Burning Appliances, lists requirements that should be followed. Because safety requirements for connector pipes (stovepipes) are not always readily available, these requirements are summarized as follows:

- Connector pipe is usually black (or blue) steel single-wall pipe; thicknesses are shown in Table 4. Stainless steel is a corrosion-resistant alternative that does not have to meet the thicknesses listed in Table 4.
- Connectors should be installed with the crimped (male) end of the pipe toward the stove, so that creosote and water drip back into the stove.
- The pipe should be as short as is practical, with a minimum of turns and horizontal runs. Horizontal runs should be pitched 20 mm per metre up toward the chimney.
- Chimney connectors should not pass through ceilings, closets, alcoves, or concealed spaces.
- When passing through a combustible interior or exterior wall, connectors must be routed through a listed wall pass-through that has been installed in accordance with the conditions of the listing, or they must follow one of the home-constructed systems recognized in NFPA *Standard* 211 or local building codes. Adequate clearance and protection of combustible materials is extremely important. In general, listed devices are easier to install and less expensive than home-constructed systems.

Creosote forms in all wood-burning systems. The rate of formation is a function of the quantity and type of fuel burned, the appliance in which it is burned, and the manner in which the appliance is operated. Thin deposits in the connector pipe and chimney do not interfere with operation, but thick deposits (greater than 6 mm) may ignite. Inspection and cleaning of chimneys connected to wood-burning appliances should be performed on a regular basis (at least annually).

Only the solid fuel that is listed for the appliance should be burned. Coal should be burned only in fireplaces or stoves designed specifically for coal burning. The chimney used in coal-fired applications must also be designed and approved for coal and wood.

Solid-fuel appliances should be installed in strict conformance with the clearance requirements established as part of their safety listing. When clearance reduction systems are used, stoves must remain at least 300 mm and connector pipe at least 150 mm from combustibles, unless smaller clearances are established as part of the listing.

Utility-Furnished Energy

Those systems that rely on energy furnished by a utility are usually required to comply with local utility service rules and regulations. The utility usually provides information on the installation and operation of the equipment using their energy. Bottled gas (LPG) equipment is generally listed and tested under the same standards as natural gas. LPG equipment may be identical to natural gas equipment, but it always has a different orifice and sometimes has a different burner and controls. The listings and examinations are usually the same for natural, mixed, manufactured, and liquid petroleum gas.

Products of Combustion

The combustion chamber of equipment that generates products of combustion must be connected by closed piping to the outdoors. Gas-fired equipment may be vented through masonry stacks, chimneys, specifically designed venting, or, in some cases, venting incorporating forced- or induced-draft fans. Chapter 35 covers chimneys, gas vents, and fireplace systems in more detail.

Agency Testing

The standards of several agencies contain guidelines for the construction and performance of in-space heaters. The following list summarizes the standards that apply to residential in-space heating; they are coordinated or sponsored by ASHRAE, the American National Standards Institute (ANSI), Underwriters Laboratories (UL), the American Gas Association (AGA), and the Canadian Gas Association (CGA). Some CGA standards have a CAN1 prefix.

ANSI Z21.11.1	Gas-Fired Room Heaters, Vented
ANSI Z21.11.2	Gas-Fired Room Heaters, Unvented
ANSI Z21.44	Gas-Fired Gravity and Fan-Type Direct-Vent Wall Furnaces
ANSI Z21.48	Gas-Fired Gravity and Fan-Type Floor Furnaces
ANSI Z21.49	Gas-Fired Gravity and Fan-Type Vented Wall Furnaces
ANSI Z21.60/ CSA 2.26-M96	Decorative Gas Appliances for Installation in Solid-Fuel Burning Fireplaces
ANSI Z21.76	Gas-Fired Unvented Catalytic Room Heaters for Use with Liquefied Petroleum (LP) Gases
ANSI Z21.50/ CSA 2.22-M98	Vented Gas Fireplaces
ANSI Z21.86/ CSA 2.32-M98	Vented Gas-Fired Space Heating Appliances
ANSI Z21.88/ CSA 2.33-M98	Vented Gas Fireplace Heaters
CAN1-2.1-M86	Gas-Fired Vented Room Heaters
CAN/CGA-2.5-M86	Gas-Fired Gravity and Fan Type Vented Wall Furnaces
CAN1/CGA-2.19-M81	Gas-Fired Gravity and Fan Type Direct Vent Wall Furnaces
NFPA 211	Chimneys, Fireplaces, Vents and Solid Fuel-Burning Appliances
NFPA/AGA 54	National Fuel Gas Code
ANSI/UL 127	Factory-Built Fireplaces
UL 574	Electric Oil Heaters
UL 647	Unvented Kerosene-Fired Heaters and Portable Heaters
ANSI/UL 729	Oil-Fired Floor Furnaces
ANSI/UL 730	Oil-Fired Wall Furnaces
UL 737	Fireplace Stoves
ANSI/UL 896	Oil-Burning Stoves
ANSI/UL 1042	Electric Baseboard Heating Equipment
ANSI/UL 1482	Heaters, Room Solid-Fuel Type
ASHRAE 62.1	Ventilation for Acceptable Indoor Air Quality

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CHAPTER 35

CHIMNEY, VENT, AND FIREPLACE SYSTEMS

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A PROPERLY designed chimney or vent system provides and controls draft to convey flue gas from an appliance to the outdoors. This chapter describes the design of chimneys and vent systems that discharge flue gas from appliances and fireplace systems.

Sustainability. Good chimney and vent design is not only a safety issue, but also can enhance a building's sustainability. This chapter explains how to design vent systems to optimize and minimize the materials used to construct fuel-burning appliance vents and chimneys for low cost and long reliability, reducing the need for vent or chimney replacement, thus saving natural resources. Also, systems designed to bring outdoor air directly into the appliance space for combustion and vent gas dilution, instead of relying on air infiltration into the building, reduce heat load and conserve fuel.

1. TERMINOLOGY

In this chapter, **appliance** refers to any furnace, boiler, or incinerator (including the burner). Unless the context indicates otherwise, the term **chimney** includes specialized vent products such as masonry, metal, and factory-built chimneys; single-wall metal pipe; type B gas vents; special gas vents; or masonry chimney liner systems (NFPA *Standard* 211). **Draft** is negative static pressure, measured relative to atmospheric pressure; thus, positive draft is negative static pressure. **Flue gas** is the mixture of gases discharged from the appliance and conveyed by the chimney or vent system.

Appliances can be grouped by draft conditions at the appliance flue gas outlet as follows (Stone 1971):

1. Those that require draft applied at the appliance flue gas outlet to induce air into the appliance
2. Those that operate without draft applied at the appliance flue gas outlet (e.g., a gas appliance with a draft hood in which the combustion process is isolated from chimney draft variations)
3. Those that produce positive pressure at the appliance flue gas outlet collar so that no chimney draft is needed; appliances that produce some positive outlet pressure but also need some chimney draft

In the first two configurations, hot flue gas buoyancy, induced-draft chimney fans, or a combination of both produces draft. The third configuration may not require chimney draft, but it should be considered in the design if a chimney is used. If the chimney system is undersized, draft inducers in the connector or chimney may supply draft needs. If the connector or chimney pressure requires control for proper operation, draft control devices must be used.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.10, Fuels and Combustion.

2. DRAFT OPERATING PRINCIPLES

Available draft D_a is the draft supplied by the vent system, available at the appliance flue gas outlet. It can be shown as

$$D_a = D_t - \Delta p - D_p + D_b \quad (1)$$

where

D_a = available draft, Pa
D_t = theoretical draft, Pa
Δp = flow losses, Pa
D_p = depressurization, Pa
D_b = boost (increase in static pressure by fan), Pa

This equation can account for a nonneutral (nonzero) pressure difference between the space surrounding the appliance or fireplace and the atmosphere. If the surrounding space is at a lower pressure than the atmosphere (space depressurized), the pressure difference D_p should also be subtracted from D_t when calculating available draft D_a, and vice versa. This equation applies to all three appliance draft conditions at the vent system inlets; for example, in the second condition with zero draft requirement at the appliance outlet, available draft required is zero, so theoretical draft of the chimney equals the flow resistance, if no depressurization or boost is present.

Satisfactory operation of the appliance and vent system depends on D_a staying within limits. If D_a is too small and the appliance design relies on D_a to draw combustion air into the burner system, incomplete combustion, flame rollout, and/or flue gas spillage can occur at the appliance. Even where combustion air is mechanically supplied to the burner, inadequate D_a can result in portions of the appliance and/or vent system operating under positive pressure. If those sections are not designed to be pressurized, flue gas can leak into the building.

Excessive D_a can cause excessive combustion air to be drawn into the burner system, which not only reduces combustion efficiency, but can also cause flame lifting or other detriments to combustion performance. Many vent systems limit D_a using a draft hood or draft regulator (integral to the appliance or field supplied); these devices limit draft by admitting dilution air into the vent system. The resulting increased flow through the vent system increases ΔP and reduces D_a. Such draft control devices are unsuitable for use in parts of vent systems that may operate with a negative D_a (positive pressure).

Various methods can be used identify the D_a limits within which an appliance can properly operate. Often, the appliance manufacturer publishes a D_a or range of D_as where the appliance is designed to operate. In other cases, acceptable values for D_a are not explicitly specified, but the manufacturer or installation code prescribes a vent system design in terms of length, chimney height, cross-sectional area, etc, that is known to provide the required D_a. An

example of the latter approach is that for Category I gas appliances (see the section on Gas Appliance Venting).

Theoretical draft D_t is the natural draft produced by the buoyancy of hot gases in the chimney relative to cooler gases in the surrounding atmosphere. It depends on chimney height, local barometric pressure, and the **mean chimney flue gas temperature difference** Δt_m, which is the difference in temperature between the flue gas and atmospheric gases. Therefore, cooling by heat transfer through the chimney wall is a key variable in chimney design. Precise evaluation of theoretical draft is not necessary for most design calculations because of the availability of chimney design charts, computer programs, and capacity tables in the references, building codes, and vent and appliance manufacturers' data sheets.

Chimney temperatures and acceptable combustible material temperatures must be known in order to determine safe clearances between the chimney and combustible materials. Safe clearances for some chimney systems, such as type B gas vents, are determined by standard tests and/or specified in building codes.

Losses from Flow Δp represent the friction losses imposed on the flue gas by flow resistance through the chimney.

Depressurization D_p is negative pressure in the space surrounding the appliance with respect to the atmosphere into which the chimney discharges. D_p can be caused by other appliances and fans operating in the building that remove or add air to the space surrounding the appliance, by building stack effect, by outdoor atmospheric effects such as wind impacting the chimney exit or the side of the building facing or leeward to the wind, and other building phenomena.

Boost D_b is the pressure boost from a mechanical-draft fan. A chimney with an forced-draft fan at the inlet of the chimney would have positive boost (increased static pressure). A chimney with an induced-draft fan at the outlet of the chimney would have negative boost (decreased static pressure).

The following sections cover the basis of chimney design for average steady-state appliance operating conditions, where significant condensation of flue products is not expected. For other appliance operating conditions, a rigorous cyclic evaluation of the flue gas and material surface temperatures in the chimney vent system can be obtained using the VENT-II computer program (GTI 2009). For oil-fired appliances, chimney flue gas and material surface temperature evaluations can be obtained using the OHVAP computer program (Krajewski 1996).

3. CHIMNEY FUNCTIONS

The proper chimney can be selected by evaluating factors such as draft, configuration, size, and operating conditions of the appliance; construction of surroundings; appliance usage classification; residential, low, medium, or high heat (NFPA *Standard* 211); and building height. The chimney designer should know the applicable codes and standards to ensure acceptable construction.

In addition to chimney draft, the following factors must be considered for safe and reliable operation: adequate air supply for combustion; building depressurization effects; draft control devices; chimney materials (corrosion and temperature resistance); flue gas temperatures, composition, and dew point; wind eddy zones; and particulate dispersion. Chimney materials must resist oxidation and condensation at both high and low fire levels at all design temperatures.

Start-Up

The equations and design charts in this chapter may be used to determine vent or chimney size for average vent system operating conditions where significant condensation of flue products is not expected. The equations and charts do not consider modulation, cycling, or time to achieve equilibrium flow conditions from a cold start. Whereas mechanical draft systems can start gas flow, gravity systems rely on the buoyancy of hot flue gases as the sole force to displace the cold air in the chimney. Priming follows Newton's laws of motion. The time to fill a system with hot flue gases, displace the cold air, and start flow is reasonably predictable and is usually a minute or less; however, unfavorable thermal differentials, building/chimney interaction, mechanical equipment (e.g., exhaust fans), or wind forces that oppose the normal flow of vent gases can overwhelm the buoyancy force. Then, rapid priming cannot be obtained solely from correct system design. The VENT-II computer program contains detailed analysis of gas vent and chimney priming and other cold-start considerations and allows for appliance cycling and pressure differentials that affect performance (GTI 2009).

Air Intakes

All rooms or spaces containing fuel-burning appliances must have a constant supply of combustion air from outdoors (either directly or indirectly) at adequate static pressure to ensure proper combustion. In addition, air (either directly or indirectly) is required to replace the air entering chimney systems through draft hoods and barometric draft regulators and to ventilate closely confined boiler and furnace rooms.

The ANSI-approved U.S. *National Fuel Gas Code* (NFPA *Standard* 54/AGA Z223.1) and the Canadian *Natural Gas and Propane Installation Code* (CSA *Standard* B149.1), along with appliance manufacturers, provide requirements for air openings. Any design must consider flow resistance of the air supply, including register-louver resistance, air duct resistance, and air inlet terminations. Compliance with these codes or the appliance manufacturers' instructions accounts for the air supply flow resistance.

Vent Size

Small residential and commercial natural-draft gas appliances need vent diameters of 75 to 300 mm. U.S. and Canadian codes recommend sizes or input capacities for most acceptable gas appliance venting materials. These sizes also apply to gas appliances with integral automatic vent dampers, as well as to appliances with field-installed automatic vent dampers. Field-installed automatic vent dampers should be listed for use with a specific appliance by a recognized testing agency and installed by qualified installers.

Draft Control

Pressure, temperature, and other draft controls have replaced draft hoods in many residential furnaces and boilers to attain higher steady-state and seasonal efficiencies. Appliances that use pulse combustion or forced- or induced-draft fans, as well as those designed for sealed combustion or direct venting, do not have draft hoods but may require special venting and special vent terminals. If fan-assisted burners deliver fuel and air to the combustion chamber and also overcome the appliance flow resistance, draft hoods or other control devices may be installed, depending on the design of the appliance. Many appliances do not use draft hoods; in such cases, the listed appliance manufacturer's vent system design requirements should be followed. The section on Vent and Chimney Accessories has information on draft hoods, barometric regulators, draft fans, and other draft control devices.

Frequently, a chimney must produce excess flow or draft. For example, dangerously high flue gas outlet temperatures from an incinerator (or normal noncondensing appliance flue gas temperatures) may be reduced by diluting the flue gas with air in the chimney (or PVC vent pipe) by applying excess draft.

Pollution Control

Where control of pollutant emissions is impossible, the chimney should be tall enough to ensure dispersion over a wide area to prevent objectionable ground-level concentrations. The chimney can

also serve as a passageway to carry flue gas to pollution control equipment. This passageway must meet the building code requirements for a chimney, even at the exit of pollution control equipment, because of possible exposure to heat and corrosion. A bypass chimney should also be provided to allow continued exhaust in the event of pollution control equipment failure, repair, or maintenance.

Equipment Location

Chimney materials may allow installation of appliances at intermediate or all levels of a high-rise building without imposing mass penalties. Some gas vent systems allow individual apartment-by-apartment heating systems.

Wind Effects

Wind and eddy currents affect discharge of gases from vents and chimneys. A vent or chimney must expel flue gas beyond the cavity or eddy zone surrounding a building to prevent reentry through openings and fresh air intakes. A chimney and its termination can stabilize the effects of wind on appliances and their equipment rooms. In many locations, the equipment room air supply is not at neutral pressure under all wind conditions. Locating the chimney outlet well into the undisturbed wind stream and away from the cavity and wake zones around a building both counteracts wind effects on the air supply pressure and prevents reentry through openings and contamination of fresh air intakes.

Chimney outlets below parapet or eaves level, nearly flush with the wall or roof surface, or in known regions of stagnant air may be subjected to downdrafts and are undesirable. Caps for downdraft and rain protection must be installed according to either their listings and the cap manufacturer's instructions or the applicable building code.

Wind effects can be minimized by locating the chimney terminal and the combustion air inlet terminal close together in the same pressure zone while taking care to minimize recirculation of combustion products into the combustion air inlet.

See Chapter 24 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, for more information on wind effects.

Safety Factors

Safety factors allow for uncertainties of vent and chimney operation. For example, flue gas must not spill from a draft hood or barometric regulator, even when the chimney has very low available draft. The Table 2 design condition for natural gas vents (i.e., vent gas at 165 K rise and 5.3% CO_2 concentration) allows gas vents to operate with reasonable safety above or below the suggested temperature and CO_2 limits.

Safety factors may also be added to the system friction coefficient to account for a possible extra fitting, soot accumulation, and air supply resistance. The specific gravity of flue gas can vary depending on the fuel burned. Natural gas flue gas, for example, has a density as much as 5% less than air, whereas coke flue gas may be as much as 8% greater. However, these density changes are insignificant relative to other uncertainties, so no compensation is needed.

4. STEADY-STATE CHIMNEY DESIGN EQUATIONS

Chimney design balances forces that produce flow against those that retard flow (e.g., friction). **Theoretical draft** is the pressure that produces flow in gravity or natural-draft chimneys. It is defined as the static pressure resulting from the difference in densities between a stagnant column of hot flue gas and an equal column of ambient air. In the design or balancing process, theoretical draft may not equal friction loss because the appliance is frequently built to operate with some specific pressure (positive or negative) at the appliance flue gas exit. This exit pressure is added to the **available draft**, which depends on chimney conditions, appliance operating characteristics, fuel, and type of draft control.

Flow losses caused by friction may be estimated by several formulas for flow in pipes or ducts, such as the equivalent length method or the loss coefficient (velocity head) method. Chapter 13 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* covers computation of flow losses. This chapter emphasizes the loss coefficient method because fittings usually cause the greater portion of system pressure drop in chimney systems, and conservative loss coefficients (which are almost independent of piping size) provide an adequate basis for design.

A computer program called VENT-II (GTI 2009) dynamically predicts cyclic flows, temperatures, and pressures in venting systems. Similarly, Krajewski (1996) developed a computer program entitled OHVAP: Oil-Heat Vent Analysis Program.

For large gravity chimneys, available draft D_a may be calculated from Equation (1).The following equations may be derived and expressed in a form that is more readily applied to the problems of chimney design, size, and capacity by considering the following factors, which are the steps used to solve the problems in the section on Vent and Chimney Capacity Calculation Examples:

1. Mass flow of combustion products in chimney
2. Chimney gas temperature and density
3. Theoretical draft
4. System pressure loss caused by flow
5. Available draft
6. Chimney gas velocity
7. System resistance coefficient
8. Final input-volume relationships

For application to system design, the chimney gas velocity step is eliminated; however, actual velocity can be found readily, if needed.

Mass Flow of Combustion Products in Chimneys and Vents

Mass flow in a chimney or venting system may differ from that in the appliance, depending on the type of draft control or number of appliances operating in a multiple-appliance system. Mass flow is preferred to volumetric flow because it remains constant in any continuous portion of the system, regardless of changes in temperature or pressure. For the chimney gases resulting from any combustion process, mass flow can be expressed as

$$w = IM \tag{2}$$

where

w = mass flow rate, kg/s
I = appliance heat input, MJ/s (MW)
M = ratio of mass flow to heat input, kg of combustion products per MJ of fuel burned (M depends on fuel composition and percentage excess air [or CO_2] in the chimney)

Volumetric flow rate (m^3/min) Q can be found as follows:

$$Q = 60\frac{w}{\rho_m} \tag{3}$$

where ρ_m is gas density (kg/m^3).

In chimney system design, the composition and flow rate of the flue gas must be assumed to determine the ratio M of mass flow to input. When combustion conditions are given in terms of excess air, Figure 1 can be used to estimate CO_2. The mass flow equations in Table 1 illustrate the influence of fuel composition; however, additional guidance is needed for system design. The information provided with many heat-producing appliances is limited to whether they have been tested, certified, listed, or approved to comply with applicable standards. From this information and from the type of fuel and draft control, certain inferences can be drawn regarding the flue gas.

Table 1 Mass Flow Equations for Common Fuels

Fuel	Ratio M of Mass Flow to Input[a]: $M = \frac{\text{kg Total Combustion Products}^b}{\text{MJ Fuel Input}}$
Natural gas	$0.303\left(0.159 + \frac{10.72}{\%\ CO_2}\right)$
LPG (propane, butane, or mixture)	$0.304\left(0.144 + \frac{12.61}{\%\ CO_2}\right)$
No. 2 oil (light)	$0.31\left(0.12 + \frac{14.4}{\%\ CO_2}\right)$
No. 6 oil (heavy)	$0.31\left(0.12 + \frac{15.8}{\%\ CO_2}\right)$
Bituminous coal (soft)	$0.327\left(0.11 + \frac{18.2}{\%\ CO_2}\right)$
Type 0 waste or wood	$0.30\left(0.16 + \frac{19.7}{\%\ CO_2}\right)$

[a]Percent CO_2 is determined in combustion products with water condensed (dry basis).
[b]Total combustion products include combustion products and excess air.

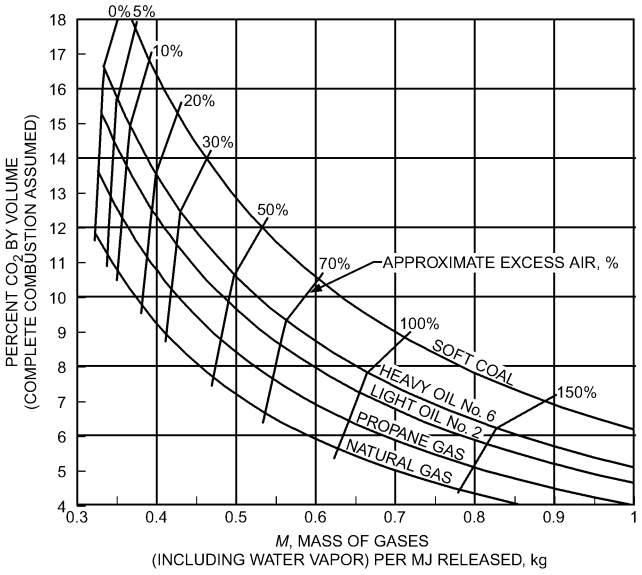


Fig. 1 Graphical Evaluation of Rate of Vent Gas Flow from Percent CO_2 and Fuel Rate

Table 2 suggests typical values for the vent or chimney systems for gaseous and liquid fuels when specific outlet conditions for the appliance are not known. If a gas appliance with draft hood is used, Table 2 recommends that dilution air through the draft hood reduce the CO_2 percentage to 5.3%. For appliances using draft regulators, the dilution and temperature reduction is a function of the draft regulator gate opening, which depends on excess draft. If the chimney system produces the exact draft necessary for the appliance, little dilution takes place.

For manifolded gas appliances that have draft hoods, dilution through draft hoods of inoperative appliances must be considered in precise system design. However, with forced-draft appliances having wind box or inlet air controls, dilution through inoperative appliances may be unimportant, especially if pressure at the outlet of inoperative appliances is neutral (atmospheric level).

Figure 2 can be used to estimate mass and volumetric flow. Flow conditions in the chimney connector, manifold, vent, and chimney vary with configuration and appliance design and are not necessarily the same as boiler or appliance outlet conditions.

Mass flow in incinerator chimneys must account for the probable heat value of the waste, its moisture content, and use of additional fuel to initiate or sustain combustion. Classifications of waste and corresponding values of M in Table 3 are based on recommendations from the Incinerator Institute of America. Combustion data given for types 0, 1, and 2 waste do not include any additional fuel. Where constant burner operation accompanies waste combustion, the additional quantity of products should be considered in the chimney design.

The system designer should obtain exact outlet conditions for the maximum rate operation of the specific appliance. This information can reduce chimney construction costs. For appliances with higher seasonal or steady-state efficiencies, however, special attention should be given to the manufacturer's venting recommendations because the flue gas may differ in composition and temperature from conventional values.

Mean Chimney Gas Temperature and Density

Chimney gas temperature depends on the fuel, appliance, draft control, chimney size, and configuration.

Density of gas within the chimney and theoretical draft both depend on gas temperature. Although the gases flowing in a chimney system lose heat continuously from entrance to exit, a single mean gas temperature must be used in either the design equation or the chart. Mean chimney gas density is virtually the same as air density at the same temperature. Thus, density may be found as

$$\rho_m = \rho_a\left(\frac{T_s}{T_m} \times \frac{B}{B_o}\right) = 0.00348\frac{B}{T_m} \quad (4)$$

where

ρ_m = chimney gas density, kg/m^3
T_s = standard temperature = 288.15 K
ρ_a = air density at T_s and B_o =1.225 kg/m^3
B = local barometric pressure, Pa
T_m = mean chimney gas temperature at average system conditions, K
B_o = standard pressure = 101 325 Pa

The density ρ_a in Equation (4) is a compromise value for typical humidity. The subscript m for density and temperature requires that these properties be calculated at mean gas temperature or vertical midpoint of a system (inlet conditions can be used where temperature drop is not significant).

Using a reasonably high ambient (e.g., 15°C) for design ensures improved operation of the chimney when ambient temperatures drop because temperature differentials and draft increase.

A design requires assuming an initial or inlet chimney gas temperature. In the absence of specific data, Table 4 provides a conservative temperature. For appliances that can operate over a range of temperatures, size should be calculated at both extremes to ensure an adequate chimney.

The drop in vent gas temperature from appliance to exit reduces capacity, particularly in sizes of 300 mm or less. In gravity type B gas vents, which may be as small as 75 mm in diameter, and in other systems used for venting gas appliances, capacity is best determined from NFPA *Standard* 54/AGA Z223.1 or CSA *Standard* B149.1. In these codes, the tables compensate for the particular characteristics of the chimney material involved, except for very high single-wall metal pipe. Between 300 and 460 mm diameters, the effect of heat loss diminishes greatly because there is greater gas flow relative to system surface area. For 500 mm and greater diameters, cooling has little effect on final size or capacity.

A straight vertical vent or chimney directly off the appliance requires little compensation for cooling effects, even with smaller sizes. However, a horizontal connector running from the appliance

Table 2 Typical Chimney and Vent Design Conditions[a]

Fuel	Appliance	% CO_2	Temperature Rise, K	Mass Flow/Input Ratio (M), kg Total Flue Gas[b] per MJ Fuel Input	Flue Gas Density,[c] kg/m³	Flow Rate/Unit Heat Input,[c] m³/s per (MJ/s) or m³/MJ at Flue Gas Temperature
Natural gas	Draft hood	5.3	165	0.661	0.777	0.851
Propane gas	Draft hood	6.0	165	0.683	0.777	0.878
Natural gas						
Low-efficiency	No draft hood	8.0	220	0.454	0.693	0.655
High-efficiency	No draft hood	7.0	135	0.512	0.832	0.615
No. 2 oil	Residential	9.0	280	0.533	0.620	0.860
Oil	Forced-draft, over 120 kW or 0.120 MJ/s	13.5	165	0.368	0.777	0.473
Waste, Type 0	Incinerator	9.0	740	0.705	0.343	2.056

[a]Values are for appliances with flue losses of 17% or more. For appliances with lower flue losses (high-efficiency types), see appliance installation instructions or ask manufacturer for operating data.
[b]Total flue gas includes combustion products and excess air.
[c]At sea level and 15.56°C ambient temperature.

Table 3 Mass Flow for Incinerator Chimneys

Type of Waste	Heat Value of Waste,[a] MJ/kg	Auxiliary Fuel[a] per Unit Waste, MJ/kg	Combustion Products		
			L/s per kg Waste at 760°C[b]	kg per kg Waste[c]	M, kg Products per MJ
0	19.8	0	11.17	13.76	0.697
1	15.1	0	8.74	10.80	0.714
2	10.0	0	6.18	7.68	0.770
3	5.8	3.5	5.12	6.25	1.075
4	2.3	7.0	4.31	5.33	2.292

[a]Auxiliary fuel may be used with any type of waste, depending on incinerator design.
[b]Specialized units may produce higher or lower outlet gas temperatures, which must be considered in chimney sizing, using Equation (12) or Equation (21).
[c]Multiply these values by kilograms of waste burned per second to establish mass flow.

Table 4 Mean Chimney Gas Temperature for Various Appliances

Appliance Type	Mean Temperature t_m* in Chimney, °C
Natural gas-fired heating appliance with draft hood (low-efficiency)	180
LP gas-fired heating appliance with draft hood (low-efficiency)	180
Gas-fired heating appliance, no draft hood	
Low-efficiency	240
Mid-efficiency	150
Oil-fired heating appliance (low-efficiency)	290
Conventional incinerator	760
Controlled air incinerator	980 to 1320
Pathological incinerator	980 to 1540
Turbine exhaust	480 to 760
Diesel exhaust	480 to 760
Ceramic kiln	980 to 1320

*Subtract 15°C ambient to obtain temperature rise.

to the base of the vent or chimney has enough heat loss to diminish draft and capacity. Figure 3 is a plot of temperature correction C_u, which is a function of connector size, length, and material for either conventional single-wall metal connectors or double-wall metal connectors.

For a more accurate method of calculating temperature loss in vents and chimneys, including effects from condensation, see Rutz et al. (1991).

To use Figure 3, estimate connector size and length and read the temperature multiplier. For example, a 5 m length of 175 mm diameter single-wall connector has a multiplier of 0.59. If inlet temperature rise Δt_e above ambient is 165 K, operating mean temperature rise Δt_m will be $0.59 \times 165 = 97$ K. This factor adequately corrects the temperature at the midpoint of the vertical vent for heights up to 30 m.

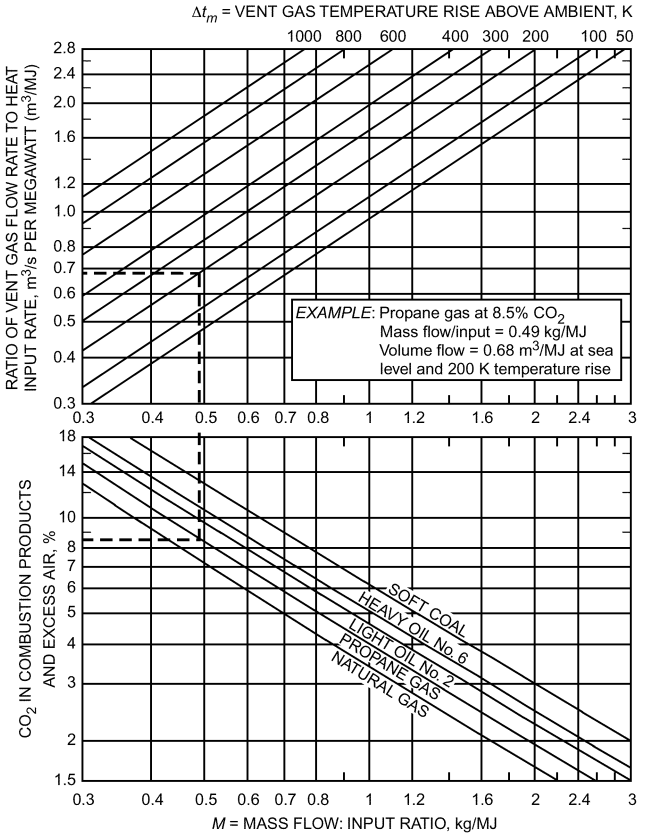


Fig. 2 Flue Gas Mass and Volumetric Flow

The correction procedure includes the assumption that the overall heat transfer coefficient of a vertical chimney is approximately 3.4 W/(m² · K) or less (the value for double-wall metal). This procedure does not correct for cooling in very high stacks constructed entirely of single-wall metal, especially those exposed to cold ambient temperatures. For severe exposures or excessive heat loss, a trial calculation assuming a conservative operating temperature shows whether capacity problems will be encountered.

For more precise heat loss calculations, Table 5 suggests overall heat transfer coefficients for various constructions installed in

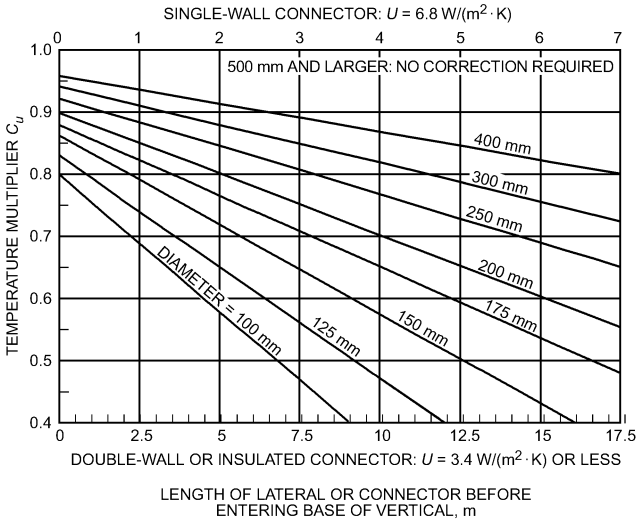


Fig. 3 Temperature Multiplier C_u for Compensation of Heat Losses in Connector

Table 5 Overall Heat Transfer Coefficients of Various Chimneys and Vents

Material	U, W/(m² · K)* Observed	Design	Remarks
Industrial steel stacks	—	7.4	Under wet wind
Clay or iron sewer pipe	7.4 to 7.9	7.4	Used as single-wall material
Asbestos-cement gas vent	4.09 to 8.06	6.8	Tested per UL *Standard* 441
Black or painted steel stove pipe	—	6.8	Comparable to weathered galvanized steel
Single-wall galvanized steel	1.76 to 7.84	5.7	Depends on surface condition and exposure
Single-wall unpainted pure aluminum	—	5.7	No. 1100 or other bright-surface aluminum alloy
Brick chimney, tile-lined	2.8 to 5.7	5.7	For gas appliances in residential construction per NFPA *Standard* 211
Double-wall gas vent, 6.4 mm air space	2.1 to 5.9	3.4	Galvanized steel outer pipe, pure aluminum inner pipe; tested per UL *Standard* 441
Double-wall gas vent, 12.7 mm air space	1.9 to 4.0	2.3	
Insulated prefabricated chimney	1.9 to 4.0	1.7	Solid insulation meets UL *Standard* 103 when chimney is fully insulated

*U-factors based on inside area of chimney.

typical environments at usual flue gas flow velocities (Segeler 1965). For masonry, any additional thickness beyond the single course of brick plus tile liner used in residential chimneys decreases the coefficient.

Equations (5) and (6) describe flow and heat transfer, respectively, in a venting system with $D_a = 0$.

$$q_m = T_s\sqrt{2g}c_p\frac{B}{B_o}\times\frac{A}{T_m}\left(\frac{H}{kT_o}\right)^{1/2}\Delta t_m^{1.5}\rho_m \quad (5)$$

$$\frac{q}{q_m} = \frac{\Delta t_e}{\Delta t_m} = \exp\left(\pi\overline{U}d_f\frac{L_m\Delta t_m}{q_m}\right) \quad (6)$$

where

A = area of passage cross section, m²
c_p = specific heat
d_i = inside diameter, m
$\exp x$ = e^x
g = gravitational constant = 9.806 65 m/s²
H = height of chimney above grade or inlet, m
k = fixed, dimensionless system flow resistance coefficient for pipe and fittings
L_m = length from inlet to location (in the vertical) of mean gas temperature, m
q = heat flow rate at vent inlet, J/s (W)
q_m = heat flow rate at midpoint of vent, J/s (W)
Δt_e = $(T - T_o)$ = temperature difference entering system, K
Δt_m = $(T_m - T_o)$ = chimney gas mean temperature rise, K
T = flue gas temperature at vent inlet, °C
T_m = chimney mean flue gas temperature, K
T_o = design ambient temperature, 288 K
T_s = 288.15 K
$\overline{U}$ = heat transfer coefficient, W/(m² · K)
ρ_m = mean flue gas density from Equation (4)

Assuming reasonable constancy of $\overline{U}$, the overall heat transfer coefficient of the venting system material, Equations (5) and (6) provide a solution for maximum vent gas capacity. They can also be used to develop cooling curves or calculate the length of pipe where internal moisture condenses. Kinkead (1962) details methods of solution and application to both individual and combined gas vents.

Theoretical Draft

The theoretical draft of a gravity chimney or vent is the difference in weight between a given column of warm (light) chimney gas and an equal column of cold (heavy) ambient air. Chimney gas density or temperature, chimney height, and barometric pressure determine theoretical draft; flow is not a factor. The equation for theoretical draft assumes chimney gas density is the same as that of air at the same temperature and pressure; thus,

$$D_t = 0.03413BH\left(\frac{1}{T_o} - \frac{1}{T_m}\right) \quad (7)$$

where

B = local barometric pressure, Pa
D_t = theoretical draft, Pa
H = height of chimney above grade or inlet, m
T_m = mean flue gas temperature at average conditions in system, K
T_o = ambient temperature, K

Theoretical draft thus increases directly with height and with the difference in density between the hot and cold columns, and is always positive (unless chimney gases are colder than ambient air).

Theoretical draft should be estimated and included in system calculations, even for appliances producing considerable positive outlet static pressure, to achieve the economy of minimum chimney size. Equation (7) may be used directly to calculate exact values for theoretical draft at any altitude. For ease of application, Table 6 lists approximate theoretical draft for typical gas temperature rises above 15°C ambient.

Appliances with fixed fuel beds, such as hand-fired coal stoves and furnaces, require positive available draft (negative gage pressure). Small oil heaters with pot-type burners, as well as residential furnaces with pressure-atomizing oil burners, need positive available draft, which can usually be set by following the manufacturer's

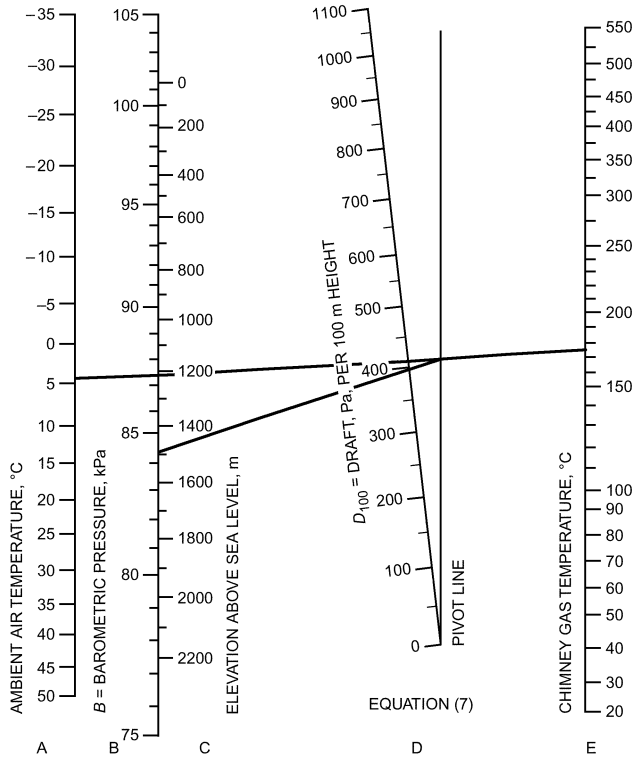


Fig. 4 Theoretical Draft Nomograph

Table 6 Approximate Theoretical Draft of Chimneys

Vent Gas Temperature Rise, K	D_t per Metre, Pa
60	2.0
100	3.0
150	4.0
200	5.0
300	6.0
400	7.0
600	8.0
900	9.0
1500	10.0

Notes: Ambient temperature = 15°C = 288 K
Chimney gas density = air density
Sea level barometric pressure = 101 325 Pa
Equation (7) may be used to calculate exact values for D_t at any altitude.

Table 7 Altitude Correction

Altitude, m	Barometric Pressure *B*, kPa	Factor*
Sea level	101.325	1.00
600	94.41	1.08
1000	89.87	1.13
2000	79.50	1.27
3000	70.11	1.45
4000	61.64	1.64

*Multiply operating input by factor to obtain design input.

instructions for setting the draft regulator. Available draft requirements for larger packaged boilers or appliances assembled from components may be negative, zero (neutral), or positive.

Compensation of theoretical draft for altitude or barometric pressure is usually necessary for appliances and chimneys functioning at elevations greater than 600 m. Depending on the design, one of the following approaches to pressure or altitude compensation is necessary for chimney sizing.

1. Equation (19): Use local theoretical draft with actual energy input, or use sea-level theoretical draft with energy input multiplied by ratio of sea level to local barometric pressure (Table 7 factor).
2. Equation (21): Use local theoretical draft and barometric pressure with volumetric flow at the local density.

The altitude correction multiplier for input (Table 7) is the only method of correcting to other elevations.

Equation (7) for theoretical draft is the basis for Figure 4, which can be used up to about 540°C and 2300 m elevation. For example, using this figure, ambient air temperature at 4.4°C and mean chimney gas temperature at 176°C provide D_{100} draft of 408 Pa per 100 m of height at 87.3 kPa (1219 m above sea level). For D_{100} draft at 84.42 kPa barometric pressure or 1493 m above sea level, follow the intersection to the pivot line and read the new D_{100} draft of 399 Pa.

Gas appliances with draft hoods, for example, are usually derated 4% per 300 m of elevation above sea level when they are operated at 610 m altitude or above (see NFPA *Standard* 54/AGA Z223.1 or CSA *Standard* B149.1). The altitude correction factor derates the design input so that the vent size at altitude for derated gas appliances is effectively the same as at sea level. For other appliances where burner adjustments or internal changes might be used to adjust for reduced density at altitude, the same factors produce an adequately compensated chimney size. For example, an appliance operating at 1830 m elevation at 2.930 MJ/s (2930 kW) input, but requiring the same draft as at sea level, should have a chimney selected on the basis of 1.244 times the operating input, or 3.645 MJ/s.

System Pressure Loss Caused by Flow

In any chimney system, flow losses, expressed as pressure drop Δp in pascals, are the difference between theoretical and available draft:

$$\Delta p = D_t - D_a \tag{8}$$

where Δp is always positive.

In any chimney or vent system, flow losses resulting from velocity and resistance can be determined from the Bernoulli equation:

$$\Delta p = \frac{k\rho_m V^2}{2} \tag{9}$$

where

k = dimensionless system resistance coefficient of piping and fittings
V = system gas velocity at mean conditions, m/s
ρ_m = mean flue gas density, kg/m^3

Pressure losses are thus directly proportional to the resistance factor and to the square of the velocity.

Available Draft

Starting with Equation (1), the difference between theoretical draft and flow losses without depressurization or boost is

$$D_a = D_t - \Delta p$$

Available draft D_a can therefore be defined as

$$D_a = 0.03413BH\left(\frac{1}{T_o} - \frac{1}{T_m}\right) - \frac{k\rho_m V^2}{2} \tag{10}$$

Table 8 Pressure Equations for Δp

Required Appliance Outlet Pressure or Available Draft D_a	Δp Equation[a]	
	Gravity Only	Gravity plus Inducer[b]
Negative, needs positive draft	$\Delta p = D_t - D_a$	$\Delta p = D_t - D_a + D_b$
Zero, vent with draft hood or balanced forced draft	$\Delta p = D_t$	$\Delta p = D_t + D_b$
Positive, causes negative draft	$\Delta p = D_t + D_a$	$\Delta p = D_t + D_a + D_b$

[a]Equations use absolute pressure for D_a.
[b]D_b = static pressure boost of inducer at flue gas temperature and rated flow.

Available draft D_a can be negative, zero, or positive. The pressure difference Δp, or theoretical minus available draft, overcomes the flow losses. Table 8 lists the pressure components for three draft configurations. Table 8 applies to still air (no wind) conditions and a neutral (zero) pressure difference between the space surrounding the appliance or fireplace and the atmosphere. Columns with and without boost are provided.

The effect of a nonneutral pressure difference on capacity or draft may be included by imposing a static pressure (either positive or negative). One way to circumvent a space-to-atmosphere pressure difference is to use a sealed-combustion system or direct-vent system (i.e., all combustion air is taken directly from the outdoor atmosphere, and all flue gas is discharged to the outdoor atmosphere with no system openings such as draft hoods). The effect of wind on capacity or draft may be included by imposing a static pressure (either positive or negative) or by changing the vent terminal resistance loss. However, a properly designed and located vent terminal should cause little change in Δp at typical wind velocities.

Although small static draft pressures can be measured at the entrance and exit of gas appliance draft hoods, D_a at the appliance is effectively zero. Therefore, all theoretical draft energy produces chimney flow velocity and overcomes chimney flow resistance losses.

Chimney Gas Velocity

Velocity in a chimney or vent varies inversely with flue gas density ρ_m and directly with mass flow rate. The equation for flue gas velocity at mean gas temperature in the chimney is

$$V = \frac{1000 \times 4w}{\pi \rho_m d_i^2} \tag{11}$$

where

V = flue gas velocity, m/s
d_i = inside diameter, mm
ρ_m = mean flue gas density, kg/m^3
w = mass flow rate, kg/s

To express velocity as a function of input and chimney gas composition, w in Equation (11) is replaced by using Equation (2):

$$V = \frac{1000 \times 4IM}{\pi \rho_m d_i^2} = \frac{1273IM}{\rho_m d_i^2} \tag{12}$$

The input capacity or diameter of a chimney may usually be found without determining flow velocity. Internal or exit velocity must occasionally be known, to ensure effluent dispersal or avoid flow noise. Also, the flow velocity of incinerator chimneys, turbine exhaust systems, and other appliances with high outlet pressures or velocities is needed to estimate piping loss coefficients.

Equations (9), (11), (12), and (20) can be applied to find velocity. The velocity may also be calculated by dividing volumetric flow rate Q by chimney area A. A similar calculation may be performed when the energy input is known. For example, a 500 mm diameter chimney serving a 4 kW propane gas appliance, at 8.5% CO_2 and 200 K above ambient in the chimney, produces (from Figure 2) 0.49 kg/MJ mass flow rate and 0.68 m^3/MJ volume flow rate at sea level. Chimney gas flow rate is

$$Q = 4 \times 0.68 = 2.72 \text{ m}^3/\text{s} \tag{13}$$

Dividing by area to obtain velocity, $V = 2.72/0.1963 = 13.86$ m/s.

Chimney gas velocity affects the piping friction factor k_L and roughness correction factor. The section on Resistance Coefficients has further information, and Example 2 illustrates how these factors are used in the velocity equations.

Chimney systems can operate over a wide range of velocities, depending on modulation characteristics of the burner system or the number of appliances in operation. Typical velocity in vents and chimneys ranges from 1.5 to 15 m/s. A chimney design developed for maximum input and maximum velocity should be satisfactory at reduced input because theoretical draft is roughly proportional to flue gas temperature rise, whereas flow losses are proportional to the square of the velocity. Thus, as input is reduced, flow losses decrease more rapidly than system motive pressures.

Effluent dispersal may occasionally require a minimum upward chimney outlet velocity, such as 15 m/s. A tapered exit cone can best meet this requirement. For example, to increase the outlet velocity from the 500 mm diameter chimney ($A = 0.1963$ m^3 area) from 12.8 to 15 m/s, the cone must have a discharge area of $0.1963 \times 12.8/15 = 0.168$ m^2 and a 460 mm diameter. An exit cone avoids excessive flow losses because the entire system operates at the lower velocity, and a resistance factor is only added for the cone. In this case, the added resistance for a gradual taper approximates the following (see Table 9):

$$k = \left(\frac{d_{i1}}{d_{i2}}\right)^4 - 1 = \left(\frac{500}{460}\right)^4 - 1 = 0.396 \tag{14}$$

Noise in chimneys may be caused by turbulent flow at high velocity or by combustion-induced oscillations or resonance. Noise is seldom encountered in gas vent systems or in systems producing positive available draft, but it may be a problem with forced-draft appliances. Turbulent flow noise can be avoided by designing for lower velocity, which may entail increasing the chimney size above the minimum recommended by the appliance manufacturer. Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* has more information on noise control.

System Resistance Coefficient

The velocity head method of determining resistance losses assigns a fixed numerical coefficient (independent of velocity) or k factor to every fitting or turn in the flow circuit, as well as to piping.

The resistance coefficient k that appears in Equations (19) and (21) summarizes the friction loss of the entire chimney system, including piping, fittings, and configuration or interconnection factors. Capacity of the chimney varies inversely with the square root of k, whereas diameter varies as the fourth root of k. The insensitivity of diameter and input to small variations in k simplifies design. Analyzing details such as pressure regain, increasers and reducers, and gas cooling junction effects is unnecessary if slightly high resistance coefficients are assigned to any draft diverters, elbows, tees, terminations, and, particularly, piping.

For any chimney with fittings, the total flow resistance is a constant plus variable piping resistance (a function of centerline length divided by diameter). Table 9 suggests moderately conservative resistance coefficients for common fittings. Elbow resistance may be lowered by long-radius turns; however, corrugated 90° elbows may have resistance values at the high end of the scale. Table 9 shows resistance as a function of inlet diameter d_{i1} and outlet diameter d_{i2}.

Table 9 Resistance Loss Coefficients

Component	Suggested Design Value, Dimensionless*	Estimated Span and Notes
Inlet acceleration (k_1)		
Gas vent with draft hood	1.5	1.0 to 3.0
Barometric regulator	0.5	0.0 to 0.5
Direct connection	0.0	Also dependent on blocking damper position
Round elbow (k_2)		
90°	0.75	0.5 to 1.5
45°	0.3	—
Tee or 90° connector (k_3)	1.25	1.0 to 4.0
Y connector	0.75	0.5 to 1.5
Cap, top (k_4)		
Open straight	0.0	—
Low-resistance (UL)	0.5	0.0 to 1.5
Other	—	1.5 to 4.5
Spark screen	0.5	—
Converging exit cone	$(d_{i1}/d_{i2})^4 - 1$	System designed using d_{i1}
Tapered reducer (d_{i1} to d_{i2})	$1 - (d_{i2}/d_{i1})^4$	System designed using d_{i2}
Increaser	—	See Chapter 2, 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals.*
Piping (k_L)	$0.033L/d_f$	Numerical coefficient (friction factor F) from 0.017 to 0.042; see Figure 12, Chapter 2, 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for size, roughness, and velocity effects.

* Initial assumption, when size is unknown: $k = 5.0$ for entire system, for first trial; $k = 7.5$ for combined gas vents only

Note: For combined gravity gas vents serving two or more appliances (draft hoods), multiply total k (components + piping; see Equations [15], [16], and [17]) by 1.5 to obtain gravity system design coefficient. (This rule does not apply to forced- or induced-draft vents or chimneys.)

System resistance k may be expressed as follows:

$$k = k_f + k_L \tag{15}$$

with

$$k_f = k_1 + n_2k_2 + n_3k_3 + k_4 + \cdots \tag{16}$$

and

$$k_L = \frac{FL}{d_i} \tag{17}$$

where

k_f = fixed fitting loss coefficient
k_L = piping resistance loss function (Figure 13, Chapter 3 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, adjusted for units)
k_1 = inlet acceleration coefficient
k_2 = elbow loss coefficient, n_2 = number of elbows
k_3 = tee loss coefficient, n_3 = number of tees
k_4 = cap, top, or exit cone loss coefficient
F = friction factor
L = length of all piping in chimney system, m
d_i = inside diameter, m

For combined gas vents using appliances with draft hoods, the summation k must be multiplied by a diversity factor of 1.5 (see Table 9 note and Example 4). This multiplier does not apply to forced- or induced-draft vents or chimneys.

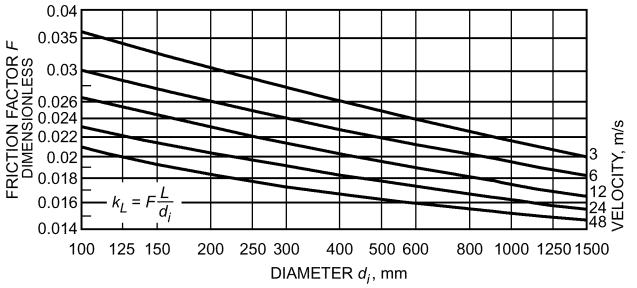


Fig. 5 Friction Factor for Commercial Iron and Steel Pipe

(Lapple 1949)

When size is unknown, the following k values may be used to run a first trial estimate:

k = 5.0 for the entire system
k = 7.5 for combined gas vents only

The resistance coefficient method adapts well to systems in which the fittings cause significant losses. Even for extensive systems, an initial assumption of $k = 5.0$ gives a tolerably accurate vent or chimney diameter in the first trial solution. Using this diameter with the piping resistance function (Equation [17]) in a second trial normally yields the final answer.

The minimum system resistance coefficient in a gas vent with a draft hood is always 1.0 because all gases must accelerate through the draft hood from almost zero velocity to vent velocity.

For a system connected directly to the outlet of a boiler or other appliance where the capacity is stated as full-rated heat input against a positive static pressure at the chimney connection, minimum system resistance is zero, and no value is added for existing velocity head in the system.

For simplified design, a value of 0.4 for F in Equation (17) applies for all sizes of vents or chimneys and for all velocities and temperatures. As diameter increases, this function becomes increasingly conservative, which is desirable because larger chimneys are more likely to be made of rough masonry construction or other materials with higher pressure losses. The 0.033 constant also introduces an increasing factor of safety for flow losses at greater lengths and heights.

Figure 5 is a plot of friction factor F versus velocity and diameter for commercial iron and steel pipe at a flue gas temperature of 150°C above ambient (Lapple 1949). The figure shows, for example, that a 1.2 m diameter chimney with a flue gas velocity of 24 m/s may have a friction factor as low as 0.016. In most cases, $k_L = 0.025\ L/d_i$ gives reasonable design results for chimney sizes 460 mm and larger because systems of this size usually operate at flue gas velocities greater than 3 m/s.

At 540°C or over, the factors in Figure 5 should be multiplied by 1.2. Because Figure 5 is for commercial iron and steel pipe, an additional correction for greater or less surface roughness may be imposed. For example, the factor for a very rough 300 mm diameter pipe may be doubled at a velocity as low as 10 m/s.

For most chimney designs, a friction factor F of 0.033 gives a conservative solution for diameter or input for all sizes, types, and operating conditions of prefabricated and metal chimneys; alternatively, $F = 0.025$ is reasonable if the diameter is 460 mm or more. Because neither input nor diameter is particularly sensitive to the total friction factor, the overall value of k requires little correction.

Masonry chimneys, including those lined with clay flue tile, may have rough surfaces, tile shape variations that cause misalignment, and joints at frequent intervals with possible mortar protrusions. In addition, the inside cross-sectional area of liner shapes may be less than expected because of local manufacturing variations, as well as

differences between claimed and actual size. To account for these characteristics, the estimate for k_L should be on the high side, regardless of chimney size or velocity.

Computations should be made by assuming smooth surfaces and then adding a final size increase to compensate for shape factor and friction loss. Performance or capacity of metal and prefabricated chimneys is generally superior to that of site-constructed masonry.

Configuration and Manifolding Effects

The most common configuration is the individual vent, stack, or chimney, in which one continuous system carries products from appliance to terminus. Other configurations include the combined vent serving a pair of appliances, the manifold serving several, and branched systems with two or more lateral manifolds connected to a common vertical system. As the number of appliances served by a common vertical vent or chimney increases, the precision of design decreases because of diversity factors (variation in the number of appliances in operation) and the need to allow for maximum and minimum input operation (Stone 1957). For example, the vertical common vent for interconnected gas appliances must be larger than for a single appliance of the same input to allow for operating diversity and draft hood dilution effects. Connector rise, headroom, and configuration in the equipment room must be designed carefully to avoid draft hood spillage and related oxygen depletion problems.

For typical combined vents, the diversity effect must be introduced into the equations by multiplying system resistance loss coefficient k by 1.5 (see Table 9 note and Example 4). This multiplier compensates for junction effect and part-load operation.

Manifolds for appliances with barometric draft regulators can be designed without allowing for dilution air through inoperative appliances. In this case, because draft regulators remain closed until regulation is needed, dilution under part load is negligible. In addition, airflow through any inoperative appliance is negligible because the combustion air inlet dampers are closed and the multiple-pass heat exchanger has a high internal flow resistance.

Manifold systems of oil-burning appliances, for example, have a lower flow velocity and, hence, lower losses. As a result, they produce reasonable draft at part load or with only one of several appliances in operation. Therefore, diversity of operation has little effect on chimney design. Some installers set each draft regulator at a slightly different setting to avoid oscillations or hunting possibly caused by burner or flow pulsations.

Calculation of the resistance coefficient of any portion of a manifold begins with the appliance most distant from the vertical portion. All coefficients are then summed from its outlet to the vent terminus. The resistance of a series of tee joints to flow passing horizontally straight through them (not making a turn) is the same as that of an equal length of piping (as if all other appliances were off). This assumption holds whether the manifold is tapered (to accommodate increasing input) or of a constant size large enough for the accumulated input.

Coefficients are assigned only to inlet and exit conditions, to fittings causing turns, and to the piping running from the affected appliance to the chimney exit. Initially, piping shape (round, square, or rectangular) and function (for connectors, vertical piping, or both) are irrelevant.

Some high-pressure, high-velocity packaged boilers require special manifold design to avoid turbulent flow noise. Figure 6 shows a typical configuration for this application. The loss coefficients listed in Table 9 for standard tees and elbows are higher than necessary for long-radius elbows or Y entries. Occasionally, on appliances with high chimneys augmenting boiler outlet pressure, it may appear feasible to reduce the diameter of the vertical portion to below the size recommended by the manufacturer. However, any reduction may cause turbulent noise, even though all normal design parameters have been considered.

With the simplifying assumption that the maximum velocity of the flue gas (which exists in the smaller of the two portions) exists throughout the entire system, and Equations (18) and (19) can be used to calculate the size of a vertical portion smaller in area than the manifold or of a chimney connector smaller than the vertical. This assumption leads to a conservative design because true losses in the larger area are lower than assumed. Further, if the size change is small, either as a contraction or expansion, the added loss coefficient for this transition fitting (see Table 9) is compensated for by reduced losses in the enlarged part of the system.

These comments on size changes apply more to individual than to combined systems because it is undesirable to reduce the vertical area of the combined type, and, more frequently, it is desirable to enlarge it. If an existing vertical chimney is slightly undersized for the connected load, the complete chart method must be applied to determine whether a pressure boost is needed, because size is no longer a variable.

Sectional gas appliances with two or more draft hoods do not pose any special problems if all sections fire simultaneously. In this case, the designer can treat them as a single appliance. The appliance installation instructions either specify the size of manifold for interconnecting all draft hoods or require a combined area equal to the sum of all attached draft hood outlet areas. Once the manifold has been designed and constructed, it can be connected to a properly sized chimney connector, vent, or chimney. If the connector and chimney size is computed as less than manifold size (as may be the case with a tall chimney), the operating resistance of the manifold will be lower than the sum of the assigned component coefficients because of reduced velocity.

The general rule for conservative system design, in which manifold, chimney connector, vent, or chimney are different sizes, can be stated as follows: Always assign full resistance coefficient values to all portions carrying combined flow, and determine system capacity from the smallest diameter carrying the combined flow. In addition, horizontal chimney connectors or vent connectors should pitch upward toward the stack at a minimum of 20 mm per metre of connector length.

Input, Diameter, and Temperature Relationships

To obtain a design equation in which all terms are readily defined, measured, or predetermined, the gas velocity and density terms must be eliminated. Using Equation (4) to replace ρ_m and Equation (12) to replace V in Equation (9) gives

$$\Delta p = \frac{k}{2}\left(\frac{T_m B_o}{\rho_o T_s B}\right)\left(\frac{4 \times 10^6\, IM}{\pi d_i^2}\right)^2 \tag{18}$$

Rearranging to solve for I and including the values of π, T_o, ρ_o, and B_o gives

$$I = 6.55 \times 10^{-8} \frac{d_i^2}{M}\left(\frac{\Delta p B}{k T_m}\right) \tag{19}$$

Solving for input using Equation (19) is a one-step process, given the diameter and configuration of the chimney. More frequently, however, input, available draft, and height are given and the diameter d_i must be found. Because system resistance is a function of the chimney diameter, a trial resistance value must be assumed to calculate a trial diameter. This method allows for a second (and usually accurate) solution for the final required diameter.

Volumetric Flow in Chimney or System

Volumetric flow Q may be calculated in a chimney system for which Equation (19) can be solved by solving Equation (9) for velocity at mean density (or temperature) conditions:

$$V = \sqrt{\frac{2\Delta p}{k\rho_m}} \tag{20}$$

This equation can be expressed in terms of the same variables as Equation (19) by using the density value ρ_m of Equation (4) in Equation (20) and then substituting Equation (20) for velocity V. Area is expressed in terms of d_i. Multiplying area and velocity and adjusting for units,

$$Q = 18.8 \times 10^{-6}\, d_i^2 \left(\frac{\Delta p T_m}{kB}\right)^{1/2} \tag{21}$$

where Q = volumetric flow rate, m^3/s. The volumetric flow obtained from Equation (21) is at mean gas temperature T_m and local barometric pressure B. Equations (19) and (21) do not account for the effects of heat transfer or cooling on flow, draft, or capacity.

Equation (21) is useful in the design of forced-draft and induced-draft systems because draft fans are usually specified in terms of volumetric flow rate at some standard ambient or selected gas temperature. An induced-draft fan is necessary for chimneys that are undersized, that are too low, or that must be operated with draft in the manifold under all conditions.

5. STEADY-STATE CHIMNEY DESIGN GRAPHICAL SOLUTIONS

Design ambient temperature is 15.6°C (288.9 K), and all temperatures given are in terms of rise above this ambient.

Theoretical draft may be corrected for altitude or reduced air density by multiplying the operating input by the factor in Table 7.

The resistance coefficient k summarizes the friction loss of the entire chimney system, including piping, fittings, and configuration or interconnection factors.

Figure 2 can be used to estimate mass and volumetric flow.

Table 6 lists approximate theoretical draft for typical gas temperature rises above 15.6°C ambient.

The equations are based on the fuel combustion products and temperatures in the chimney system.

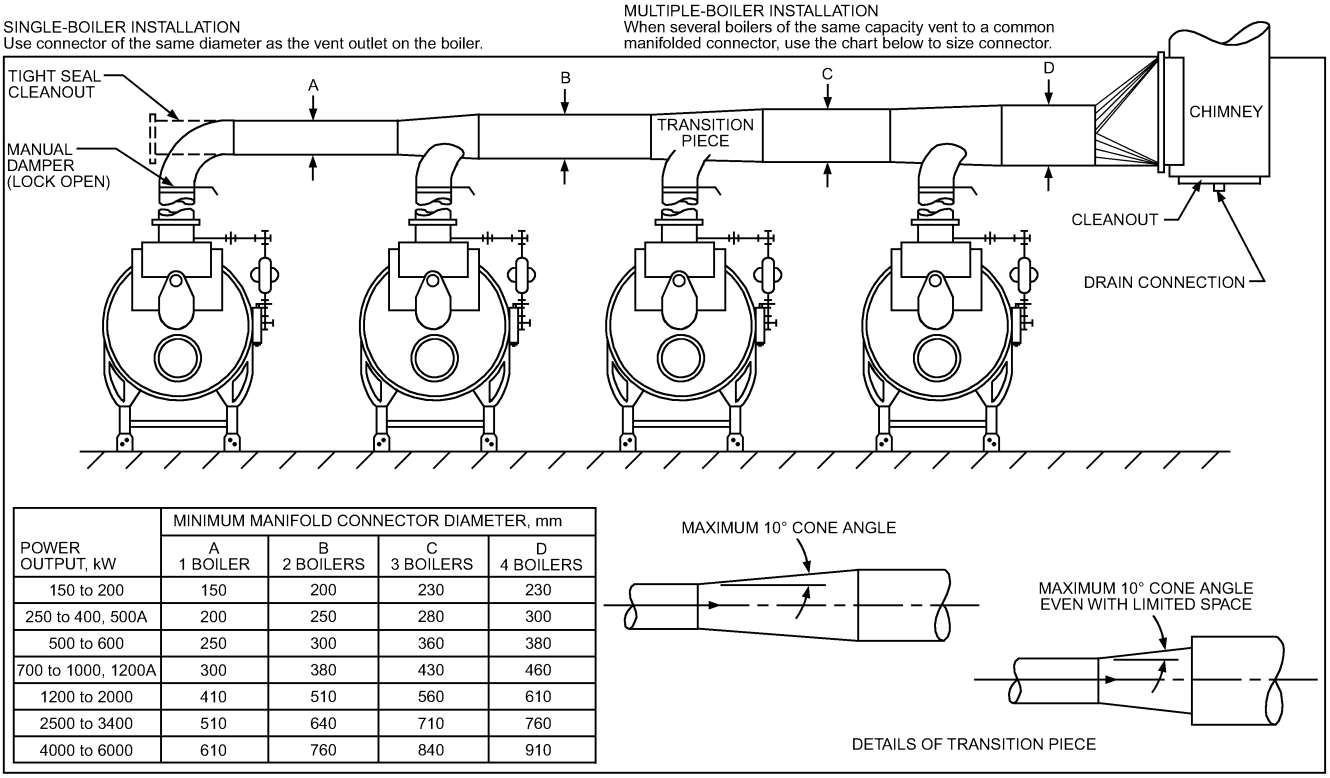
The first trial solution for diameter, using Equations (19) and (21), need not consider the cooling temperature multiplier, even for small sizes. A first approximate size can be used for the temperature multiplier for all subsequent trials because capacity is insensitive to small changes in temperature.

The equations do not contain the same number or order of steps as the derivation; for example, a step disappears when theoretical and available drafts are combined into Δp. Similarly, the examples selected vary in their sequence of solution, depending on which parameters are known and on the need for differing answers, such as diameter for a given input, diameter versus height, or the amount of pressure boost D_b from a forced-draft fan.The following sample calculation illustrates the direct solution for input, velocity, and volume.

Example 1. Find the input capacity (MJ/s) of a vertical, double-wall type B gas vent, 600 mm in diameter, 30 m high at sea level. This vent is used with draft hood natural-gas-burning appliances.

Solution:

1. Mass flow from Table 2. $M = 0.661$ kg/MJ for natural gas, if no other data are given.
2. Temperature from Table 4. Temperature rise = 165 K and $T_m = 180 + 273 = 453$ K for natural gas.



POWER OUTPUT, kW	MINIMUM MANIFOLD CONNECTOR DIAMETER, mm			
	A 1 BOILER	B 2 BOILERS	C 3 BOILERS	D 4 BOILERS
150 to 200	150	200	230	230
250 to 400, 500A	200	250	280	300
500 to 600	250	300	360	380
700 to 1000, 1200A	300	380	430	460
1200 to 2000	410	510	560	610
2500 to 3400	510	640	710	760
4000 to 6000	610	760	840	910

Fig. 6 Typical Connector Design

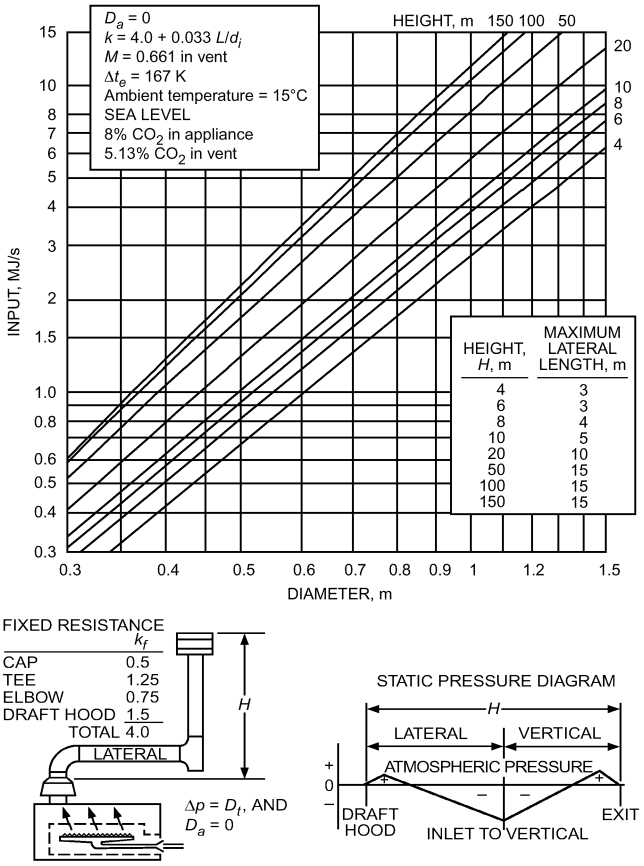


Fig. 7 Gas Vent with Lateral

3. Theoretical draft from Table 6 or Equation (7). For 30 m height at 165 K rise, D_t = 131 Pa.
4. Available draft for draft hood appliances: D_a = 0.
5. Flow losses from Table 8. $\Delta p = D_t$ = 131 Pa; flow losses for a gravity gas vent equal theoretical draft at mean gas temperature.
6. Resistance coefficients from Table 9. For a vertical vent,

Draft hood	k_1 =	1.5
Vent cap	k_4 =	1.0
30 m piping	$k_L = 0.033(30/0.6)$ =	1.65
System total	k =	4.15

7. Solution for input.

   Altitude: Sea level, B = 101 325 Pa from Table 7. d_i = 600 mm. These values are substituted into Equation (19) as follows:

$$I = 6.55 \times 10^{-8} \frac{(600)^2}{0.661}\left(\frac{(131)(101\ 325)}{(4.15)(453)}\right)^{1/2}$$

$$I = 3.00 \text{ MJ/s input capacity}$$

8. A solution for velocity requires a prior solution for input to apply to Equation (12). First, using Equation (4),

$$\rho_m = 0.00348\left(\frac{101\ 325}{453}\right) = 0.778 \text{ kg/m}^3$$

From Equation (12),

$$V = \frac{4 \times 10^6 (3.00)(0.661)}{(3.14)(0.778)(600)^2} = 9.01 \text{ m/s}$$

9. Volume flow can now be found because velocity is known. The flow area of 600 mm diameter is 0.283 m^2, so

$$Q = 0.283 \times 9.01 = 2.55 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$$

No heat loss correction is needed to find the new flue gas temperature because the size is greater than 500 mm, and this vent is vertical with no horizontal connector.

6. VENT AND CHIMNEY CAPACITY CALCULATION EXAMPLES

Figures 7 to 10 show chimney capacity for individually vented appliances computed by the methods presented. These capacity curves may be used to estimate input or diameter for Equation (19) or Equation (21). These capacity curves apply primarily to individually vented appliances with a lateral chimney connector; systems with two or more appliances or additional fittings require a more detailed analysis. Figures 7 to 10 assume the length of the horizontal connector is (1) at least 3 m and (2) no longer than 50% of the height or 15 m, whichever is less. For chimney heights of 3 to 6 m, a fixed 3 m long connector is assumed. Between 6 and 30 m, the connector is 50% of the height. If the chimney height exceeds 30 m, the connector is fixed at 15 m long.

For a chimney of similar configuration but with a shorter connector, the size indicated in the figures is slightly larger than necessary. In deriving the data for Figures 7 to 10, additional conservative assumptions were used, including the temperature correction C_u for double-wall laterals (see Figure 3) and a constant friction factor (0.033) for all sizes.

The loss coefficient k_4 for a low resistance cap is included in Figures 7, 8, and 9. If no cap is installed, these figures indicate a larger size than needed.

Figure 7 applies to a gas vent with draft hood and a lateral that runs to the vertical section. Maximum static draft is developed at the base of the vertical, but friction reduces the observed value to less than the theoretical draft. Areas of positive pressure may exist at the elbow above the draft hood and at the inlet to the cap. The height of the system is the vertical distance from the draft hood outlet to the vent cap.

Figure 8 applies to a typical boiler system requiring both negative combustion chamber pressure and negative static outlet pressure. The chimney static pressure is below atmospheric pressure, except for the minor outlet reversal caused by cap resistance. Height of this system is the difference in elevation between the point of draft measurement (or control) and the exit. (Chimney draft should not be based on the height above the boiler room floor.)

Figure 9 shows the use of a negative static pressure connector serving a forced-draft boiler. This system minimizes flue gas leakage in the equipment room. The draft is balanced or neutral, which is similar to a gas vent, with zero draft at the appliance outlet and pressure loss Δp equal to theoretical draft.

Figure 10 applies to a forced-draft boiler capable of operating against a positive static outlet pressure of up to 125 Pa. The chimney system has no negative pressure, so outlet pressure may be combined with theoretical draft to get minimum chimney size. For chimney heights or system lengths less than 125 Pa, the effect of adding 125 Pa positive pressure to theoretical draft causes all curves to fall into a compressed zone. An appliance that can produce 125 Pa positive forced draft (negative draft) is adequate for venting any simple arrangement with up to 30 m of flow path and no wind back pressure, for which additional forced draft is required.

The following examples illustrate the use of the corresponding equations.

Example 2. Gravity incinerator chimney (see Figure 11).

Located at 2400 m elevation, the appliance burns 75 g/s of type 0 waste with 100% excess air at 760°C outlet temperature. Ambient

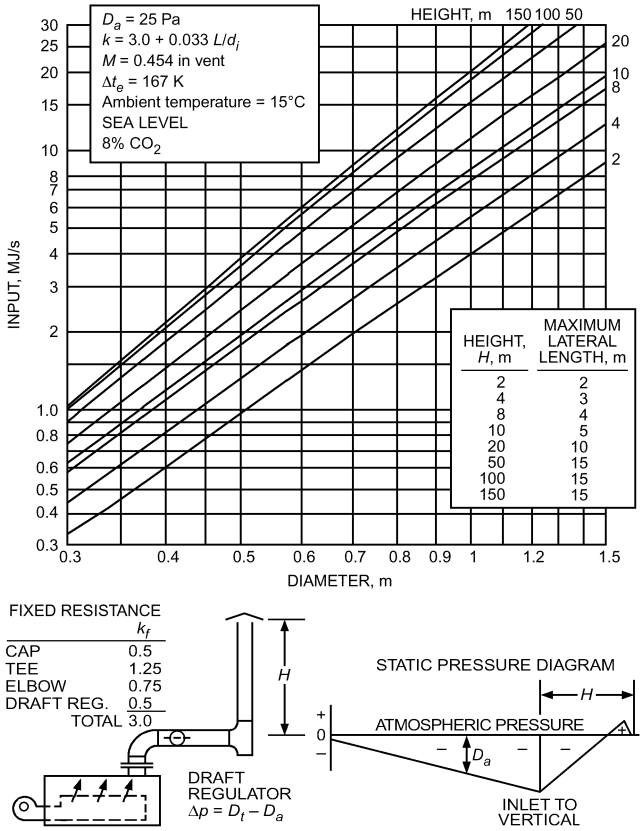


Fig. 8 Draft-Regulated Appliance with 25 Pa Available Draft Required

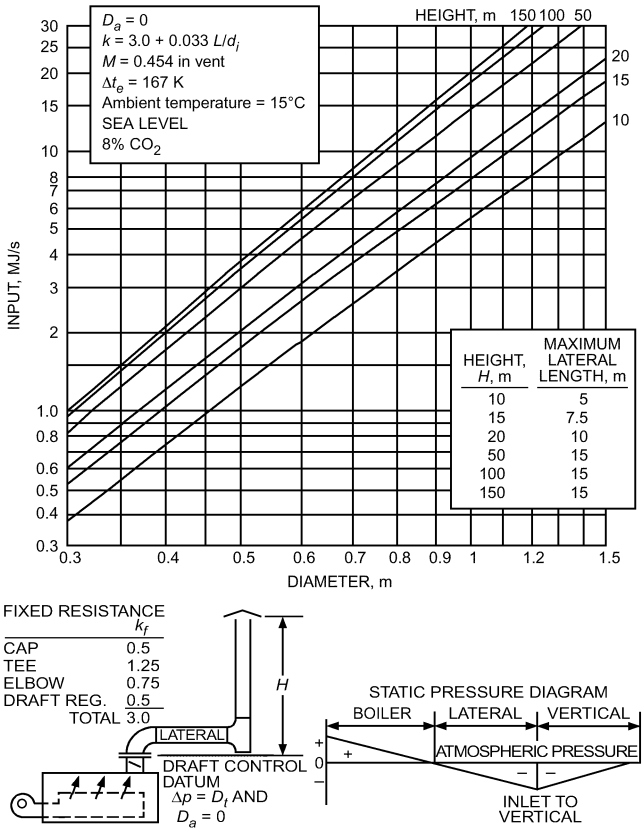


Fig. 9 Forced-Draft Appliance with Neutral (Zero) Draft (Negative Pressure Lateral)

temperature T_o is 15°C. Outlet pressure is zero at low fire, and +75 Pa at high fire. The chimney will be a prefabricated medium-heat type with an 18 m connector and a roughness factor of 1.2. The incinerator outlet is 460 mm in diameter, and it normally uses a 6 m vertical chimney. Find the diameter of the chimney and the connector and the height required to overcome flow and fitting losses.

Solution:

1. Find mass flow from Table 3 as 13.76 kg combustion products per kilogram of waste, or $w = 75 \times 13.76 = 1032$ g/s total.
2. Find mean chimney gas temperature. Based on 18 m length of 460 mm diameter double-wall chimney, $C_u = 0.83$ (see Figure 3). Temperature rise $\Delta t_e = 760 - 15 = 745$ K; thus, $\Delta t_m = 745(0.83) = 618$ K rise above 15°C ambient. $T_m = 618 + 15 + 273 = 906$ K. Use this temperature in Equation (4) to find flue gas density at 2400 m elevation (from Table 7, $B = 75.7$ kPa):

$$\rho_m = 0.00348\left(\frac{75\ 700}{906}\right) = 0.291 \text{ kg/m}^3$$

3. Find the required height by finding theoretical draft per metre from Equation (7) (Table 6 applies only to sea level).

$$\frac{D_t}{H} = (0.0314)(75\ 700)\left(\frac{1}{288} - \frac{1}{906}\right)$$

$$= 6.12 \text{ Pa per metre of height}$$

4. Find allowable pressure loss Δp in the incinerator chimney for a positive-pressure appliance having an outlet pressure of +25 Pa. From Table 8, $\Delta p = D_t + D_a$, where $D_t = 6.12H$, $D_a = 0.25$, and $\Delta p = 6.12H + 25$ Pa.
5. Calculate flow velocity at mean temperature from Equation (11) to balance flow losses against diameter/height combinations:

$$V = \frac{(1000 \times 4)(1032)}{(3.14)(0.291)(460)^2} = 21.4 \text{ m/s}$$

This velocity exceeds the capability of a gravity chimney of moderate height and may require a draft inducer if a 460 mm chimney must be used. Verify velocity by calculating resistance and flow losses by the following steps.

6. From Table 9, resistance coefficients for fittings are

1 Tee	$k_3 = 1.25$
1 Elbow	$k_2 = 0.75$
Spark screen	$k_4 = 0.50$
Fitting total	$k_f = 2.50$

The piping resistance, adjusted for length, diameter, and a roughness factor of 1.2, must be added to the total fitting resistance. From Figure 5, find the friction factor F at 460 mm diameter and 21.4 m/s as 0.0183. Assuming 6 m of height with an 18 m lateral, piping friction loss is

$$k_L = \frac{1.2FL}{d_i} = \frac{(1.2)(0.0183)(18+6)}{460/1000} = 1.15$$

and total $k = 2.50 + 1.15 = 3.65$

Use Equation (9) to find Δp, to determine whether this chimney height and diameter are suitable.

$$\Delta p = \frac{(3.65)(0.291)(21.4)^2}{2} = 243 \text{ Pa flow loss}$$

For these operating conditions, theoretical draft plus available draft yields

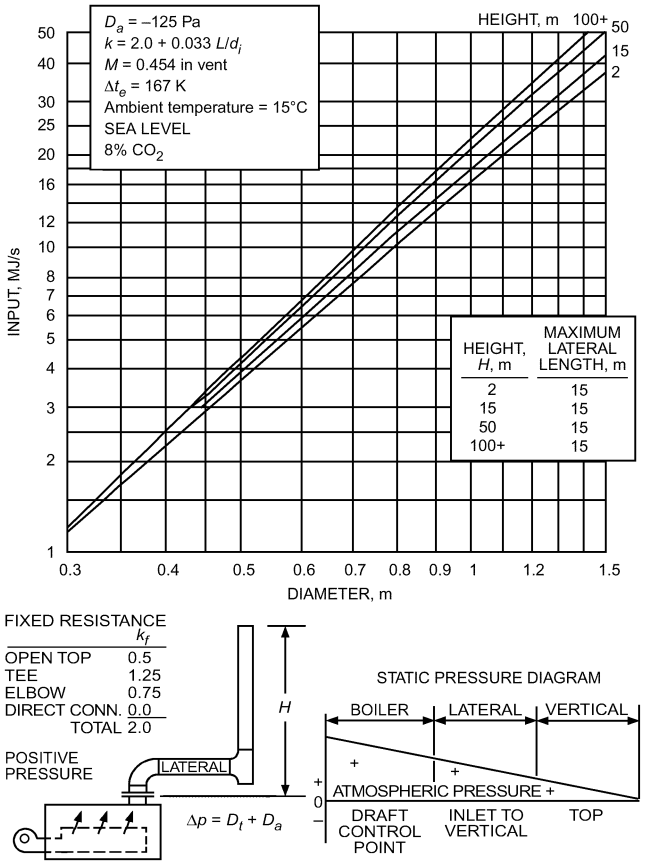


Fig. 10 Forced-Draft Appliance with Positive Outlet Pressure (Negative Draft)

$$\Delta p = (6.12 \times 6) + 25 = 62 \text{ Pa driving force}$$

Flow losses of 243 Pa exceed the 62 Pa driving force; thus, the selected diameter, height, or both are incorrect, and this chimney will not work. This can also be shown by comparing draft per metre with flow losses per metre for the 460 mm diameter configuration:

Flow losses per metre of 460 mm chimney = 243/(18 + 6) = 10 Pa

Draft per metre of height = 6.12 Pa

Regardless of how high the chimney is, losses caused by a 21.4 m/s velocity build up faster than draft.

7. A draft inducer could be selected to make up the difference between losses of 243 Pa and the 62 Pa driving force. Operating requirements are

$$Q = \frac{w}{(1000\rho_m)} = \frac{1032}{(1000 \times 0.291)} = 3.55 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$$

Δp = 243 – 62 = 181 Pa at 3.55 m^3/s and 618 K rise

If the inducer selected (see Figure 25C) injects single or multiple air jets into the gas stream, it should be placed only at the chimney top or outlet. This location requires no compensation for additional air introduced by an enlargement downstream from the inducer.

Because 460 mm is too small, assume that a 610 mm diameter may work at a 6 m height and recalculate with the new diameter.

1. As before, w = 1032 g/s.
2. At 610 mm diameter, no temperature correction is needed for the 18 m connector. Thus, T_m = 760 + 273 = 1033 K (see Table 4), and density is

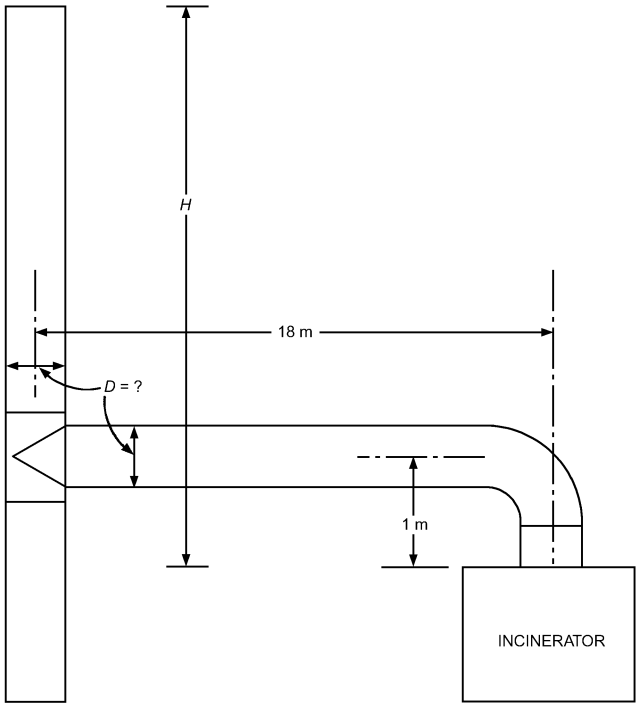


Fig. 11 Illustration for Example 2

$$\rho_m = 0.00348\left(\frac{75\ 700}{1033}\right) = 0.255 \text{ kg/m}^3$$

3. Theoretical draft per metre of chimney height is

$$\frac{D_t}{H} = 0.03413\ (75\ 700)\left(\frac{1}{288} - \frac{1}{1033}\right) = 6.47 \text{ Pa/m}$$

4. Velocity is

$$V = \frac{(1000 \times 4)(1032)}{(3.14)(0.255)(610)^2} = 13.86 \text{ m/s}$$

5. From Figure 5, the friction factor is 0.0188, which, when multiplied by a roughness factor of 1.2 for the piping used, becomes 0.0226. For the entire system with k_f = 2.50 and 24 m of piping, find k = 2.5 + 0.0226(24/0.610) = 3.39. From Equation (9),

$$\Delta p = \frac{(3.39)(0.255)(13.86)^2}{2} = 83.0 \text{ Pa flow losses}$$

$D_t + D_a$ = 6 × 6.47 + 25 = 64 Pa, so driving force is less than losses. The small difference indicates that, although 6 m of height is insufficient, additional height may solve the problem. The added height must make up for 19 Pa additional draft. As a first approximation,

Added height = Additional draft/draft per metre
= 19/6.47 = 2.94 m
Total height = 6 + 2.94 = 8.94 m

This is less than the actual height needed because resistance changes have not been included. For an exact solution for height, the driving force can be equated to flow losses as a function of H. Substituting H = +18 for L in Equation (15) to find k for Equation (9),

$$k = k_f + k_L = k_f + (FL/d_i) = 2.5 + (0.0226 \times 18/0.610) = 3.17$$

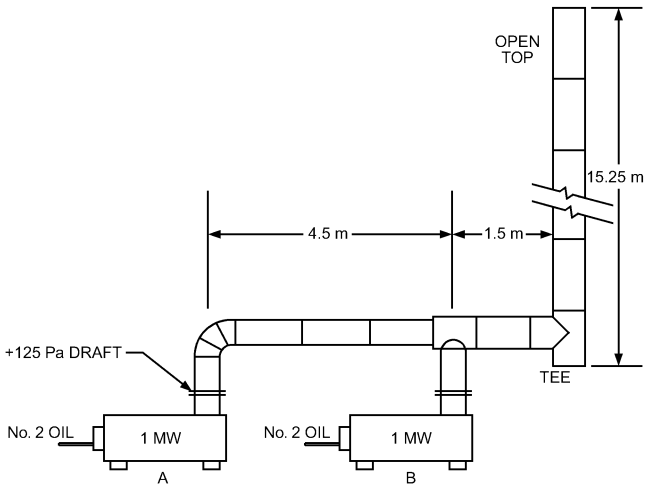


Fig. 12 Illustration for Example 3

$$\text{Driving force} = \Delta p = \frac{k\rho_m V^2}{2}$$

$$25 + 6.47H = \frac{\left[3.17 + (0.0226)\left(\frac{1}{0.610}\right)H\right](0.255)(13.86)^2}{2}$$

$H = 9.464$ m at 610 mm diameter.

Checking by substitution, total driving force = 85.95 Pa and total losses, based on a system with 27.415 m of piping, equal 85.95 Pa.

The value of $H = 9.464$ m is the minimum necessary for proper system operation. Because of the great variation in fuels and firing rate with incinerators, greater height should be used to ensure adequate draft and combustion control. An acceptable height would be from 12 to 15 m.

Example 3. Two forced-draft boilers (see Figure 12).

This example shows how multiple-appliance chimneys can be separated into subsystems. Each boiler is rated 1 MJ/s (1 MW) on No. 2 oil. The manufacturer states flue gas operation at 13.5% CO_2 and 165 K temperature rise against 125 Pa positive static pressure at the outlet. The 15.25 m high chimney has a 6 m single-wall manifold and is at sea level. Find the size of connectors, manifold, and vertical.

Solution: First, find the capacity or size of the piping and fittings from boiler A to the tee over boiler B. Then, size the boiler B tee and all subsequent portions to carry the combined flow of A and B. Also, check the subsystem for boiler B; however, because its shorter length compensates for greater fitting resistance, its connector may be the same size as for boiler A.

Find the size for combined flow of A and B either by assuming $k = 5.0$ or by estimating that the size will be twice that found for boiler A operating by itself. Estimate system resistance for the combined portion by including those fittings in the B connector with those in the combined portion.

Data needed for the solution of Equation (19) for boiler A for No. 2 oil at 13.5% CO_2 include the following:

$$M = 0.31\left(0.12 + \frac{14.4}{13.5}\right) = 0.368 \text{ kg/MJ} \qquad \text{(from Table 1)}$$

For a temperature rise of 165 K and an ambient of 15°C,

$$T_m = 165 + 15 + 273 = 453 \text{ K}$$

Interpolating from Table 6, theoretical draft = 4.3 Pa per metre of height; for 15.25 m height, $D_t = (4.3)(15.25) = 65.6$ Pa.

Using a positive outlet pressure of 125 Pa as available draft, $\Delta p = 65.6 + 125 = 190.6$ Pa.

Assume $k = 5.0$. Assuming 80% efficiency, input is 1.25 MJ/s. Substitute in Equation (19):

$$I = 1.25 - 6.55 \times 10^{-8}\,\frac{d_i^2}{0.368}\left(\frac{190.6 \times 101\,325}{5.0 \times 453}\right)^{1/2}$$

Solving, $d_i = 276$ mm as a first approximation. From Table 9, find correct k using next largest diameter, or 300 mm:

Inlet acceleration (direct connection)	k_1	= 0.0
90° Elbow	k_2	= 0.75
Tee	k_3	= 1.25
21.25 m piping	k_L	= 0.033(21.25) = 2.34
System total	k	= 4.34

Note: Assume tee over boiler B has $k = 0$ in subsystem A.

Corrected temperature rise (see Figure 3 for 6 m single-wall connector) = 0.75 × 165 = 124 K, and $T_m = 124 + 15 + 273 = 412$ K. This corrected temperature rise changes D_t to 3.61 Pa/m (Table 6 or Equation [7]), or 55.1 Pa for 15.25 m. Thus, Δp becomes 55.1 + 125 = 180.1 Pa.

$$125 = 6.55 \times 10^{-8}\,\frac{d_i^2}{0.368}\left(\frac{180.1 \times 101\,325}{4.34 \times 412}\right)^{1/2}$$

So $d_i = 264$ mm, or a 300 mm diameter is adequate.

For size of manifold and vertical, starting with the tee over boiler B, assume 400 mm diameter (see also Figure 10).

System $k = 3.88$ for the 16.75 m of piping from B to outlet:

Inlet acceleration	k_1	= 0.0
Two tees (boiler B subsystem)	k_3	= 2.5
16.75 m piping	k_L	= 0.033(16.75/0.4) = 1.38
System total	k	= 3.88

Temperature and Δp will be as corrected (a conservative assumption) in the second step for boiler A. Having assumed a size, find input.

$$I = 6.55 \times 10^{-8}\,\frac{400^2}{0.368}\left(\frac{180.1 \times 101\,325}{3.88 \times 412}\right)^{1/2} = 3.04 \text{ MJ/s}$$

A 400 mm diameter manifold and vertical is more than adequate. Solving for the diameter at the combined input, $d_i = 364$ mm; thus, a 400 mm chimney must be used.

Note: Regardless of calculations, do not use connectors smaller than the appliance outlet size in any combined system. Applying the temperature correction for a single-wall connector has little effect on the result because positive forced draft is the predominant motive force for this system.

Example 4. Six gas boilers manifolded at 1825 m elevation (see Figure 13).

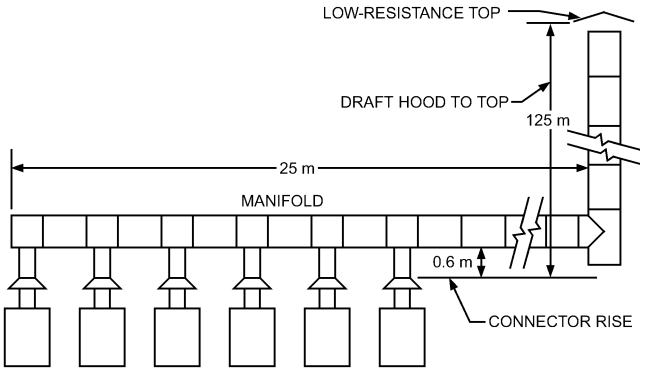


Fig. 13 Illustration for Example 4

Each boiler is fired at 0.5 MJ/s, with draft hoods and an 25 m long manifold connecting into a 125 m high vertical. Each boiler is controlled individually. Find the size of the constant-diameter manifold, vertical, and connectors with a 0.6 m rise. All are double-wall.

Solution: Simultaneous operation determines both the vertical and manifold sizes. Assume the same appliance operating conditions as in Example 1: CO_2 = 5.3%, natural gas, flue gas temperature rise = 165 K. Initially assume k = 5.0 is multiplied by 1.5 for combined vent (see note at bottom of Table 9); thus, design k = 7.5. For a gas vent at 125 m height, $\Delta p = D_t = H \times D_t/m = 125 \times 4.3 = 537$ Pa rise 165 K in Table 6; D_t = 4.3 Pa/m. At 1825 m elevation, operating input must be multiplied by an altitude correction (Table 7) of 1.25. Total design input is 0.5(6)(1.25) = 3.75 MW. From Table 2, M = 0.661 kg/MJ at operating conditions. T_m = 165 + 15 + 273 = 453 K, and B = 101 325 Pa because the 1.25 input multiplier corrects back to sea level. From Equation (19),

$$0.5 \times 6 \times 1.25 = 3.75 = 6.55 \times 10^{-8} \frac{d_i^2}{0.661}\left(\frac{537 \times 101\ 325}{7.5 \times 453}\right)^{1/2}$$

$$d_i = 547 \text{ mm}$$

Because the diameter is greater than 500 mm, no temperature correction is needed.

Recompute k for 25 + 125 m of 600 mm diameter (Table 9):

Draft hood inlet acceleration		k_1 = 1.5
Two tees (connector and base of chimney)		$2k_3$ = 2.5
Low-resistance top		k_4 = 0.5
150 m piping	$k_L = 0.033(150/0.6)$	= 8.25
System total		k = 12.75

Combined gas vent design k = multiple vent factor 1.5 × 12.75 = 19.12. Substitute again in Equation (19):

$$3.75 = 6.55 \times 10^{-8} \left(\frac{d_i^2}{0.661}\right)\left(\frac{537 \times 101\ 325}{19.12 \times 453}\right)^{1/2}$$

$$d_i = 691 \text{ mm; thus use 700 mm}$$

$$k_f = 4.5$$
$$k_L = 0.033(150/0.700) = 7.1$$
$$k = 11.6$$

$$(1.5)(11.6) = 17.4$$

Substitute in Equation (19) to obtain the third trial:

$$3.75 = 6.55 \times 10^{-8} \frac{d_i^2}{0.661}\left(\frac{537 \times 101\ 325}{17.4 \times 453}\right)^{1/2}$$

$$d_i = 675 \text{ mm}$$

The third trial is less than the second and again shows the manifold and vertical chimney diameter to be between 600 and 700 mm.

For connector size, see the *National Fuel Gas Code* (NFPA *Standard* 54/AGA *Standard* Z223.1) for double-wall connectors of combined vents. The height limit of the (I-P only) table is 30.48 m (100 ft); do not extrapolate and read the capacity of 457 mm (18 in.) connector as 510 MJ/s (MW) (1 740 000 Btu/h) at 610 mm (2 ft) rise. Use 457 mm connector or draft hood outlet, whichever is larger. No altitude correction is needed for connector size; the draft hood outlet size considers this effect.

Note: Equation (19) can also be solved at local elevation for exact operating conditions. At 1825 m, the local barometric pressure is 81.3 kPa (interpolated from Table 7), and assumed theoretical draft must be corrected in proportion to the reduction in pressure:

D_t = 537(81.3/101 325) = 431 Pa. Operating input of 6 × 0.5 = 3 MJ/s is used to find d_i, again taking final k = 17.4:

$$0.5 \times 6 = 6.55 \times 10^{-8} \left(\frac{d_i^2}{0.661}\right)\left(\frac{431 \times 81\ 300}{17.4 \times 453}\right)^{1/2}$$

$$d_i = 674 \text{ mm (virtually the) same as above)}$$

This example illustrates the equivalence of the two solutions. Equation (19) gives the correct solution using either method 1, with only the fuel input corrected back to sea-level condition, or method 2, correcting Δp for local barometric pressure and using operating input at altitude.

Example 5. Pressure boost for undersized chimney (not illustrated).

A natural gas boiler at sea level (no draft hood) is connected to an existing 300 mm diameter chimney. Input is 1.15 MJ/s with flue gas at 10% CO_2 and 165 K temperature rise above ambient. System resistance loss coefficient k = 5.0 with 6 m high chimney. The appliance operates with neutral outlet static draft, so, D_a = 0 Pa.

a. How much draft boost is needed at operating temperature?
b. What fan rating is required at 15°C ambient temperature?
c. Where in the system should the fan be located?

Solution: Combustion data: from Figure 2, 10% CO_2 at 165 K temperature rise indicates 0.48 m^3/s per megawatt (m^3/MJ).

Total flow rate $Q = 0.48 \times 1.15 = 0.552$ m^3/s at chimney gas temperature. Then, Equation (21) can be solved for the only unknown, Δp:

$$0.552 = 18.8 \times 10^{-6}(300)^2 \left[\frac{\Delta p(165 + 15 + 273)}{5.0 \times 101\ 325}\right]^{1/2}$$

Δp = 119 Pa needed at 165 K temperature rise. For 6 m of height at 165 K temperature rise (Table 6 or Equation [7]),

(per Table 6) $D_t = 4.3 \times 6 = 25.8$ Pa

(per Equation [7])

$$D_t = 0.03413\ BH\ [(1/T_o) - (1/T_m)]$$
$$= 0.03413 \times 101\ 325 \times 6\ \{[1/288] - [1/(288 + 165)]\}$$
$$= 26.2 \text{ Pa}$$

a. Pressure boost D_b supplied by the fan must equal Δp minus theoretical draft (Table 8) when available draft is zero. $D_b = \Delta p - D_t$ = 119 – 26 = 93 Pa at operating temperature.

b. Draft fans are usually rated for standard ambient (15°C) air. Pressure is inversely proportional to absolute flue gas temperature. Thus, for ambient air,

$$D_b = 93\frac{T_m}{T_o} = 93\left(\frac{165 + 15 + 273}{15 + 273}\right) = 146 \text{ Pa}$$

This pressure is needed to produce 93 Pa at operating temperature. In specifying power ratings for draft fan motors, a safe policy is to select one that operates at the required flow rate at ambient temperature and pressure (see Example 6).

c. A fan can be located anywhere from boiler outlet to chimney outlet. Regardless of location, the amount of boost is the same; however, chimney pressure relative to atmosphere will change. At boiler outlet, the fan pressurizes the entire connector and chimney. Thus, the system should be gastight to avoid leaks. At the chimney outlet, the system is below atmospheric pressure; any leaks flow into the system and seldom cause problems. With an ordinary sheet metal connector attached to a gastight vertical chimney, the fan may be placed close to the vertical chimney inlet. Thus, the connector leaks safely inward, while the vertical chimney is under pressure.

Example 6. Draft inducer selection (see Figure 14).

A third gas boiler must be added to a two-boiler system at sea level with an 450 mm diameter, 4.6 m horizontal, and 23 m of total height of connector and chimney system. Outlet conditions for natural gas draft hood appliances are 5.3% CO_2 at 165 K temperature rise. Boilers are controlled individually, each with 0.5 MJ/s, for 1.5 MJ/s total input. The system is currently undersized for gravity full-load operation. Find capacity, pressure, size, and power rating of a draft inducer fan installed at the outlet.

Solution: Using Equation (21) requires evaluating two operating conditions: (1) full input at 165 K rise and (2) no input with ambient air. Because the boilers are controlled individually, the system may operate

at nearly ambient temperature (55 K flue gas temperature rise or less) when only one boiler operates at part load. Use the system resistance k for boiler 3 as the system value for simultaneous operation. It needs no compensating increased draft, as with gravity multiple venting, because a fan induces flow at all flue gas temperatures. From Table 9, the resistance summation is

Inlet acceleration (draft hoods)	k_1 =	1.50
Tee above boiler	k_3 =	1.25
Tee at base of vertical	k_3 =	1.25
27.6 m of 450 mm diameter pipe	$k_L = 0.033(27.6/0.45)$ =	2.02
System total	k =	6.02

At full load, $T_m = 165 + 15 + 273 = 453$ K; $B = 101\,325$ Pa. Flow rate Q must be found for operating conditions of 0.661 kg/MJ (Table 2) at density ρ_m and full input 1.5 MJ/s.

From Equation (4),

$$\rho_m = 0.00348B/T_m = 0.00348(101\,325/453) = 0.778 \text{ kg/m}^3$$

Volumetric flow rate is

$$Q = \frac{0.661 \times 1.5}{0.778} = 1.27 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$$

For 165 K flue gas temperature rise, $D_t = 4.3 \times 23 = 98.9$ Pa theoretical draft in the system (Table 6). Solving Equation (21) for Δp,

$$\Delta p = \frac{(6.02)(101\,325)(1.27)^2}{(18.8 \times 10^{-6})^2 (450)^4 (453)} = 150 \text{ Pa}$$

Thus, a fan is needed because Δp exceeds D_t. Required static pressure boost (Table 8) is

$D_b = 150 - 98.9 = 51.1$ Pa at 165 K flue gas temperature rise or a flue gas density of 0.778 kg/m^3

Fans are rated for ambient or standard air (15 to 20°C) conditions. Flue gas pressure is directly proportional to density or inversely proportional to absolute temperature. Moving 1.27 m^3/s of flue gas at 165 K temperature rise against 51.1 Pa pressure requires the static pressure boost with standard air to be

$$D_b = 51.1(453/288) = 80.4 \text{ Pa}$$

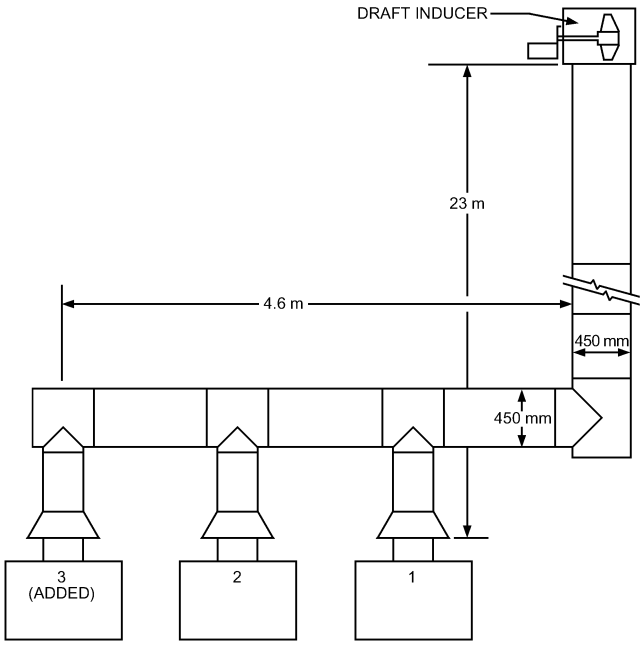


Fig. 14 Illustration for Example 6

Thus, a fan that delivers 1.27 m^3/s of flue gas at 80.4 Pa at 15°C is required. Figure 15 shows the operating curves of a typical fan that meets this requirement. The exact volume flow rate and pressure developed against a system k of 6.02 can be found for this fan by plotting airflow rate versus Δp from Equation (21) on the fan curve. The solution, at point C, occurs at 0.92 m^3/s, where both the system Δp and fan static pressure equal 130 Pa.

Although some fan manufacturers' ratings are given at standard air conditions, the motors selected will be overloaded at temperatures below 165 K air temperature rise. Figure 15 shows that power required for two conditions with ambient air is as follows:

1. 0.92 m^3/s at 130 Pa static pressure requires 0.42 kW
2. 1.27 m^3/s at 80.4 Pa static pressure requires 0.40 kW

Thus, the minimum size motor will be 0.40 kW brake power and run at 1590 rpm.

Manufacturers' literature must be analyzed carefully to discover whether the sizing and selection method is consistent with appliance and chimney operating conditions. Final selection requires both a thorough analysis of fan and system interrelationships and consultation with the fan manufacturer to verify the fan and motor capacity and power ratings.

7. GAS APPLIANCE VENTING

In much of the United States, gas-burning appliances requiring venting of combustion products are installed and vented in accordance with the *National Fuel Gas Code* (NFPA *Standard* 54/AGA Z223.1), and in Canada with the *Natural Gas and Propane Installation Code* (CAN/CSA *Standard* B149.1). This standard includes capacity data and definitions for commonly used gas vent systems. In addition, these codes group vented gas-fired appliances by draft and flue gas conditions as follows:

- Category I appliances operate with nonpositive vent static pressure and a vent gas temperature that avoids excessive condensate production in the vent.

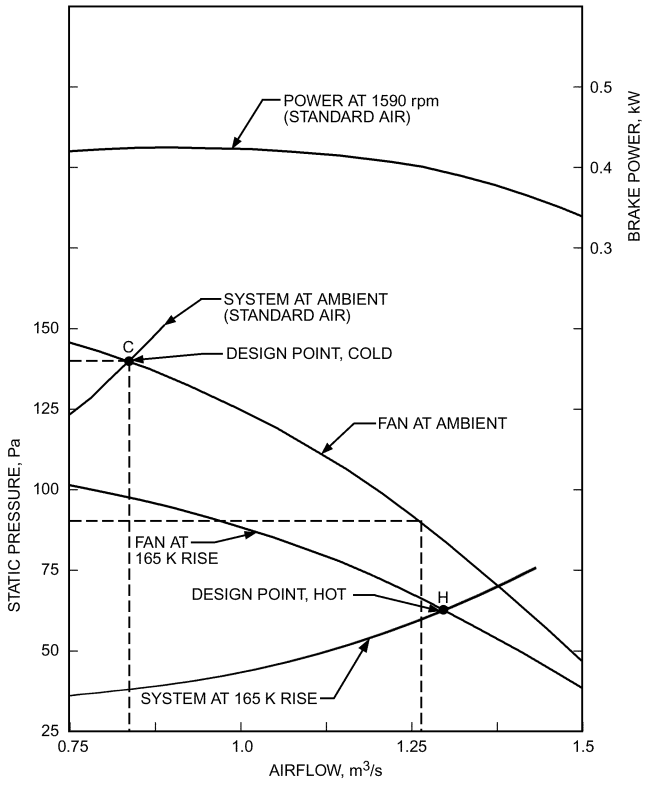


Fig. 15 Typical Fan Operating Data and System Curves

- Category II appliances operate with nonpositive vent static pressure and a vent gas temperature that may cause condensate production in the vent.
- Category III appliances operate with positive vent static pressure and a vent gas temperature that avoids excessive condensate production in the vent.
- Category IV appliances operate with positive vent static pressure and a vent gas temperature that may cause condensate production in the vent.

Category I appliances are further divided into two broad types: **natural-draft** appliances rely solely on flue gas buoyancy to draw combustion air through the appliance/vent system and are equipped with draft hood (integral or external to the appliance itself) used to limit draft at the outlet of the appliance. **Fan-assisted** appliances use a blower to move combustion air through the appliance, but rely on flue gas buoyancy alone to move flue products through the vent system (vent pressure at the outlet of the appliance is zero or negative). From a vent design standpoint, the difference between these two types of Category I appliances is important because the vent systems used with natural-draft Category I appliances must handle not only the products of combustion, but also dilution air drawn into the system through the draft hood. Dilution air increases the total gas volume that must be handled by the vent system, and therefore reduces the capacity of a given size vent system. However, a given vent system handling less dilution air tends to be more prone to forming flue gas condensate, particularly under transient conditions, which can cause corrosion or drainage problems when present in excessive amounts.

Both the National Fuel Gas Code (ANSI/NFPA *Standard* 54/ANSI/AGA Z223.1) and the Natural Gas and Propane Installation Code (CAN/CSA *Standard* B149.1) include tables and other information that can be used to design vent systems for one or more Category I appliances. These tables include maximum capacities, representing the largest appliance input rating that could safely be vented using a given vent diameter, height, lateral, and material. For reasons discussed previously, these capacities are larger for fan-assisted appliances than they are for natural draft appliances. At the same time, these tables specify a *minimum* capacity for a given size chimney used to vent fan assisted appliances to minimize condensate formation. Minimizing condensate formation, as well as the time required to "prime" the chimney (establish draft when the chimney is initially cold) are the reasons for limitations placed by the above codes on the use of single wall vent connectors, and masonry chimneys.

Category I guidelines in these codes were developed using the VENT-II computer program (GTI 2009) to perform transient analysis with the appliance(s) cycling. Gas-fired central furnace cycle times of 3.87 min on, 13.3 min off, 17.17 min total, were determined based on a design outdoor ambient of –14.7°C with an oversize factor of 1.7. One criterion used in developing these guidelines is that the vent connector dry before the end of the appliance on cycle, whereas the vertical portion of the vent is required to dry out before the end of the total cycle.

Methods for determining the category of a given gas appliance vary. ANSI *Standards* Z21.13, Z21.47, and Z21.10 include category determination tests for boilers, furnaces, and water heaters and include a requirement that the resulting category be marked on the appliance's data plate. Appliances not certified to one of these standards may not be categorized at all or may be categorized in a way inconsistent with ANSI test procedures. In such cases, caution should be exercised in attempting to use the venting guidelines mentioned in this section.

No universal venting guidelines exist for Category II, III, or IV appliances. In many cases, guidelines for such an appliance are defined by the appliance manufacturer in terms of an acceptable range of vent length, diameter, material, and terminal design. In such cases, the appliance manufacturer may also specify the means of condensate disposal and vent terminal location. Criteria used to develop these guidelines primarily include maintaining draft (or pressure) at the appliance outlet within acceptable limits, avoiding corrosion damage caused by condensate, and withstanding wind loads. ANSI *Standards* Z21.13, Z21.47, and Z21.10 include performance tests to establish these guidelines and require the manufacturer to publish them in the installation manual. In some cases the appliance manufacturer may specify an acceptable range of draft (or pressure) at the appliance outlet, rather than defining the vent system geometry.

Vent Connectors

Vent connectors connect gas appliances to the gas vent, chimney, or single-wall metal pipe, except when the appliance flue outlet or draft hood outlet is connected directly to one of these vent systems. Materials for vent connectors for conversion burners or other appliances without draft hoods must have resistance to corrosion and heat not less than that of galvanized 0.701 mm thick sheet steel. Where a draft hood is used, the connector must have resistance to corrosion and heat not less than that of galvanized 0.475 mm thick sheet steel or type B vent material.

Masonry Chimneys for Gas Appliances

A masonry chimney serving a gas-burning appliance should have a tile liner and should comply with applicable building codes such as NFPA *Standard* 211. The *National Fuel Gas Code* has other provisions pertaining to masonry chimneys. An additional chimney liner may be needed to avoid slow priming and/or condensation, particularly for an exposed masonry chimney with high mass and low flue gas temperature. A low-temperature chimney liner may be a single-wall passage of pure aluminum or stainless steel or a double-wall type B vent.

Type B and Type L Factory-Built Venting Systems

Factory-prefabricated vents are listed by Underwriters Laboratories for use with various types of fuel-burning appliances. These vents should be installed according to the manufacturer's instructions and the appliance's listing.

Type B gas vents are listed for vented gas-burning appliances. They should not be used for incinerators, appliances readily converted to the use of solid or liquid fuel, or combination gas-oil burning appliances. They may be used in multiple gas appliance venting systems.

Type BW gas vents are listed for vented wall furnaces certified as complying with the pertinent ANSI standard.

Type L venting systems are listed by Underwriters Laboratories in 75 to 150 mm sizes and may be used for those oil- and gas-burning appliances (primarily residential) certified or listed as suitable for this type of venting. Under the terms of the listing, a single-wall connector may be used in open accessible areas between the appliance's outlet and the type L material in a manner analogous to type B. Type L piping material is recognized in the *National Fuel Gas Code* and NFPA *Standard* 211 for certain connector uses between appliances such as domestic incinerators and chimneys.

Gas Appliances Without Draft Hoods

The equations may be used to calculate chimney size for nonresidential gas appliances with the draft configurations listed as 1 and 3 at the beginning of this chapter. Draft conditions 1 and 3 (see draft conditions 1, 2, and 3 under Terminology and Table 8) for residential gas appliances, such as boilers and furnaces, may require special vent systems. The appliance test and certification standards include evaluation of manufacturers' appliance installation instructions (including the vent system) and of operating and application conditions that affect venting. The instructions must be followed strictly.

Conversion to Gas

Installation of conversion burner equipment requires evaluating for proper chimney draft and capacity by the methods in this chapter or by conformance to local regulations. The physical condition and suitability of an existing chimney must be checked before it is converted from a solid or liquid fuel to gas. For masonry chimneys, local experience may indicate how well the construction will withstand the lower temperature and higher moisture content of natural or liquefied petroleum gas combustion products. The section on Masonry Chimneys for Gas Appliances has more details.

The chimney should be relined, if required, with corrosion-resistant masonry or metal to prevent deterioration. The liner must extend beyond the top of the chimney. The chimney drop-leg (bottom of the chimney) must be at least 100 mm below the bottom of the connection to the chimney. The chimney should be inspected and, if needed, cleaned. The chimney should also have a cleanout at the base.

8. OIL-FIRED APPLIANCE VENTING

Oil-fired appliances requiring venting of combustion products must be installed and vented in accordance with ANSI/NFPA *Standard* 31. The standard offers recommendations for metal relining of masonry chimneys.

Recommendations for minimum chimney areas for oil-fired natural-draft appliances are offered in Tables 3 and 4 in the HYDI (1989).

Implementation of the U.S. National Appliance Energy Conservation Act (NAECA) of 1987 brought attention to heating appliance efficiency and the effect of NAECA on existing chimney systems. Oil-fired appliances maintained a steady growth in efficiency since the advent of the retention-head oil burner and its broad application in both new appliances and the replacement of older burners in existing appliances. Higher appliance efficiencies brought about lower flue gas temperatures. Reduced firing rates became more common as heating appliances were more closely matched to the building heating load. Burner excess air levels also dropped, which resulted in lower mass flows through the chimney and additional reductions in the flue gas temperature. However, the improvements in overall appliance efficiency have not been accompanied by upgrades in existing chimney systems, and upgraded systems are not commonly applied in new construction. An upgrade in a vent system probably involves application of corrosion-resistant materials and/or the reduction in heat loss from the vent system to maintain draft and reduce condensation on interior surfaces of the vent system.

Condensation and Corrosion

Condensation and corrosion within the vent system are of growing concern as manufacturers of oil-fired appliances strive to improve equipment efficiencies. The conditions for condensation of the corrosive components of the flue gas produced in oil-fired appliances involve a complex interaction of the water formed in the combustion process and the sulfur trioxide formed from small quantities of sulfur in the fuel oil. The sulfur is typically less than 0.5% by mass for no. 2 fuel oil. The dew point of the two-component system (sulfuric acid and water) in the flue gas resulting from the combustion of this fuel is about 107 to 116°C. This is similar to the effect on dew point of fuel gas sulfur (see Figure 5 in Chapter 28 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). In determining the proper curve for fuel oil in that figure, a value of 111 may be used. This value applies to no. 2 fuel oil with 0.5% sulfur by mass.

The effect of post-combustion air dilution on the dew point characteristics of flue gas from oil-fired appliances is highly dependent on the presence of sulfur in the fuel. Verhoff and Banchero (1974) developed an equation relating flue gas dew point to the partial pressures of both water and sulfuric acid present in the flue gas. Predictions obtained using this equation are in good agreement with experimental data. Applying this equation to the flue gas from the combustion of no. 2 fuel oil without sulfur and with varying sulfur contents reveals that a broad range of dew point temperatures is possible.

For a fuel oil with zero sulfur and 20% excess combustion air, dew point of the combustion products is calculated as approximately 45.6°C, typical for the presence of water formed in combustion. With the addition of post-combustion dilution air to a level equivalent to increasing the excess air in the flue gas to 100%, the apparent water dew point is reduced to 37.2°C. For fuel oil with 0.25% sulfur and 20% excess combustion air, the dew point is elevated to 109.4°C because of formation of dilute sulfuric acid in the flue gas. With the addition of post-combustion dilution air, the dew point is 113.9°C at 100% excess air and 112.2°C at 200% excess air. The implication of these calculations is that, for combustion of fuel oil, the flue gas dew-point temperature can range from a low at the apparent water dew point (calculated with no fuel sulfur) up to some elevated dew point caused by the presence of sulfur in the fuel. With no sulfur in the fuel, adding post-combustion dilution air to the flue gas has some effect on depressing the apparent water dew-point temperature. Adding post-combustion dilution air has no significant effect on the elevated flue gas dew point when sulfur is present in the fuel.

It is difficult to meet the flue-gas-side material surface temperatures required to exceed the elevated dew point at all points in the venting system of an oil-fired appliance. Even if the dew-point temperature is not reached at these surfaces, however, a surface temperature approaching 93.3°C allows condensation of sulfuric acid at higher concentrations and results in lower rates of corrosion.

The condensed acid concentration is critical to the applicability of plain carbon and stainless steels in vent connectors and chimney liners. The flue-gas-side surface temperatures of conventional connectors and masonry chimney tile liners are often at or below the dew point for some portion of the burner on period. During cooldown (burner off period), these surface temperatures can drop to below the apparent water dew point and, in some cases, to ambient conditions. This is of great concern because, while system surfaces are below the apparent water dew point during burner operation, the condensed sulfuric acid is formed in concentrations well below limits acceptable for steel connectors. This can be seen from an interpretation of a sulfuric acid/water phase diagram presented by Land (1977). An estimate of the condensed liquid sulfuric acid concentration at a condensing surface temperature of 48.9°C, for example, shows a concentration for the condensed liquid acid of about 10 to 20%.

According to Fontana and Greene (1967), the relative corrosion of plain carbon steel rises rapidly at sulfuric acid concentrations below 65%. According to Land (1977), for the condensed liquid acid concentration to rise above 65%, the condensing surface temperature must be above 93.3°C. However, according to Fontana and Greene, at acid concentrations above 65%, corrosion rates increase at metal surface temperatures above 79.4°C. This presents the designer with a restrictive operating range for steel surfaces (i.e., between 79.4 and 93.3°C). This is a compromise that does not completely satisfy either the acid concentration or the metal temperature criterion, but should minimize the corrosion rates induced by each.

Another important phenomenon is that when vent system surfaces are at or below the apparent water dew point, a large amount of water condensation occurs on these surfaces. This condensate contains, in addition to sulfuric acid, quantities of sulfurous, nitrous, carbonic, and hydrochloric acids. Under these conditions, the corrosion rate of commonly used vent materials is severe. Koebel and

Elsener (1989) found that corrosion rates increase by a factor of 10 when material temperatures on the flue gas side are allowed to fall below the apparent water dew point.

The applicability of ordinary stainless steels is very limited and generally follows that of plain carbon steel. Nickel-molybdenum and nickel-molybdenum-chromium alloys show good corrosion resistance over a wide range of sulfuric acid concentrations for surface temperatures up to 104.4°C. This is also true for high-silicon cast iron, used in heat exchangers for oil-fired appliances, and which might find application as a liner system for masonry and metal chimneys.

Connector and Chimney Corrosion

Water and acid condensation can each result in corrosion of the connector wall and deterioration of the chimney material. Although there is little documentation of specific failures, concern in the industry is growing. The volume of anecdotal information regarding corrosive failures is significant and well supported by findings from the heating industry.

For oil-fired appliances, the rate of acid corrosion in the connector and chimney is a function of combustion factors and operational factors. The sulfur content of the fuel and the percent excess combustion air are the major combustion-related factors. The frequency and duration of equipment on and off periods, draft control dilution air, and rate of heat loss from the vent system are the major operational factors. In terms of combustion, Butcher and Celebi (1993) found a direct correlation of acid deposition (condensation) rate and subsequent corrosion to fuel sulfur content and excess combustion air. In general, reductions in fuel sulfur and excess combustion air reduce the amount of sulfuric acid produced in combustion and delivered to condensing surfaces in the appliance heat exchanger and carried over into the vent system. From an operational standpoint, long equipment on and short off periods and low vent system heat loss result in shorter warm-up transients and higher end-point temperatures for surfaces exposed to the flue gas. Within the limits of frictional loss, reduced vent sizes increase flue gas velocities and vent surface temperatures.

Vent Connectors

An oil-fired appliance is commonly connected to a chimney through a connector pipe. Generally, a draft control device in the form of a barometric damper is included as a component part of the connector assembly. With the advent of new power burners having high static pressure capability, draft control devices in the vent system have become less important, although many local codes still require their use. The portion of the connector assembly between the appliance flue collar and the draft control is called the flue connector; the portion between the draft control and the chimney is called the stack or chimney connector.

Chimney connectors are usually of single-wall galvanized steel. The required wall thickness for these connectors varies as a function of pipe diameter. For example, in accordance with Table 9.2.2.3 in NFPA *Standard* 211, the material thickness for galvanized steel pipe connectors between 150 and 250 mm in diameter is set at 0.58 mm.

In accordance with the 2015 *National Fuel Gas Code*, Paragraph 12.11.2.3(2), vent, chimney, stack, and flue connectors should not be covered with insulation except listed insulated connectors installed according to the terms of their listing. Because single-wall connectors must remain uninsulated for inspection, substantial cooling of the connector wall and the flue gas can occur, especially with long connector runs through spaces with low ambient temperatures. Close examination of the connector joints, seams, and surfaces is essential whenever the heating appliance is serviced. If the connector is left unrepaired, corrosion damage can cause a complete separation failure of the connector and leakage of flue gas into the occupied space.

Where corrosion in the connector has proven to be a chronic problem, consider replacing the connector with a type L vent pipe or its listed equivalent. One product configuration consists of connector pipe with a double wall (stainless steel inner and galvanized steel outer with 6.4 mm gap). The insulated gap of this type of double-wall connector elevates inner wall surface temperature and reduces the overall connector heat loss.

Masonry Chimneys for Oil-Fired Appliances

A masonry chimney serving an oil-fired appliance should have a tile liner and should comply with applicable building codes such as NFPA *Standard* 211. An additional listed chimney liner may be needed to improve thermal response (warm-up) of the inner chimney surface, thereby reducing transient low draft during start-up and acid/water condensation during cyclic operation. This is particularly true for exposed exterior high-mass chimneys but does not exclude cold interior chimneys serving oil-fired appliances that produce relatively low flue gas temperatures. Application of insulation around tile liners within masonry chimneys is common in Europe and may be worth considering in chimney replacement or new construction.

A computational analysis by Krajewski (1996) using the U.S. Department of Energy's *Oil Heat Vent Analysis Program* (OHVAP; version 3.1) to analyze a series of masonry chimney systems with various firing rates and exit temperatures revealed that current applications of modern oil-fired heating appliances may have problems with acid/water condensation during winter operation. For residential oil-fired heating appliance firing rates below 1.3 to 1.6 mL/s with flue-loss steady-state efficiencies of 82% or higher, exterior masonry chimneys may need special treatment to reduce condensation. For conservative design, listed chimney liners and listed type L connectors may be required for some exterior chimneys serving equipment operating under these conditions.

Replacement of Appliances

The physical condition and suitability of an existing chimney must be checked before installation of a new oil-fired appliance. The chimney should be inspected and, if necessary, cleaned. In accordance with NFPA *Standard* 211, the chimney drop-leg (bottom of the chimney flue) must be at least 200 mm below the bottom of the appliance connection to the chimney. The liner must be continuous, properly aligned, and intact and must extend beyond the top of the chimney. The chimney should also have a properly installed, reasonably airtight clean-out at the base.

For masonry chimneys, local experience may indicate how well the construction has withstood the lower temperatures produced by a modern oil-fired appliance. Visual examination reveals evidence of potential or existing chimney damage. Exterior indicators such as missing or loose mortar/bricks, white deposits (efflorescence) on brickwork, a leaning chimney, or water stains on interior building walls should be investigated further. Interior chimney examination with a mirror or video camera can reveal damaged or missing liner material. Any debris collected in the chimney base, drop-leg, or connector should be removed and examined. If any doubt exists about the chimney's condition, examination by an experienced professional is recommended. Kam et al. (1993) offer specific guidance on the examination and evaluation of existing masonry chimneys in the field.

9. FIREPLACE CHIMNEYS

This section is condensed from an *ASHRAE Journal* article; for more details, please see Stone (1969).

Fireplaces with natural-draft chimneys follow the same gravity fluid flow law as gas vents and thermal flow ventilation systems. All thermal or buoyant energy is converted into flow, and no draft exists

over the fire or at the fireplace inlet. Formulas have been developed to study a wide range of fireplace applications, but the material in this section covers general cases only.

Mass flow of hot flue gases through a vertical pipe is a function of rate of heat release and the chimney area, height, and system pressure loss coefficient k. The flow induced in a vertical pipe has a limiting value. A fireplace may be considered as a gravity duct inlet fitting with a characteristic entrance-loss coefficient and an internal heat source. A fireplace functions properly (does not smoke) when adequate intake or face velocity across those critical portions of the frontal opening nullifies external drafts and internal convection effects.

In a fireplace-chimney system, the equations assume that all potential buoyant energy is converted into flow as controlled by various losses. This system is analogous to a gas venting system with a draft hood, thereby allowing use of similar concepts as a starting point for size or capacity analysis. The amount of available draft ahead of the fireplace opening is insignificant and need not be considered. Because chimney efficiency, by one definition, equals available draft divided by theoretical draft, the numerical efficiency value approaches zero. Thus, the flow conversion basis is preferable for design over the efficiency approach.

System parameters for preventing flue gas spillage from a draft hood or similar collection fitting, can be computed with considerable certainty when heat input is constant or cannot exceed a predictable limiting value. Fireplaces, however, can be fired at extremes ranging from smoldering embers to flash fires of newspapers or dry kindling. Normal opening width and length allow greater access of combustion air to fires than a typical chimney can carry away; thus, combustion overloading occasionally leads to some smoking. At low rates of combustion, airflow velocities into the fireplace face are less than the velocity of natural convection currents induced at side walls by heat stored in the brick, allowing wisps of smoke to stray away from the combustion products' main flow path. Smoking tendencies are compounded at low firing rates by indoor/outdoor pressure differentials caused by winds, thermal forces, or fans, because the accompanying thermal force (buoyancy) of low combustion products temperature is insufficient to overcome strong wind or fan effects.

In the following analysis, note that fireplaces are primarily air-collecting hoods, diluting a small amount of combustion products with large amounts of air. Maximum mass flow of air into any given fireplace chimney is limited, and diminishes past a certain maximum. Thus, as combustion rate increases, combustion product temperatures rise to the point where masonry cracks; metals overexpand, warp, and oxidize; and steady smoking can occur because heated flue gases evolve beyond the limited capacity of the chimney.

An inoperative fireplace is completely at the mercy of indoor/outdoor pressure differences caused by winds, building stack effects, and operation of forced-air heating systems or mechanical ventilation. Thus, smoking during start-up can have complex causes seldom related to the chimney. Increasingly in new homes and especially in high-rise multiple family construction, fireplaces of normal design cannot cope with mechanically induced reverse flow or shortages of combustion air. It is mandatory in these circumstances to treat and design a fireplace as a constantly operating mechanical exhaust system, with induced-draft blowers (mechanical-draft systems) that can overpower other mechanized air-consuming systems, and can develop sufficient flow to avoid smoking and excessive flue temperatures.

The gravity-flow capacity equation (Kinkead 1962) of a fireplace-chimney system equates mass flow with the resultant system driving forces and losses.

$$w = A_c \left(\frac{2gH}{k}\right)^{1/2} [\rho_m (\rho_o - \rho_m)]^{1/2} \tag{22}$$

where

w = flue gas flow rate, kg/s
A_c = chimney flue cross-sectional area, m^2
g = gravitational constant, 9.8 m/s^2
H = height of chimney above lintel, m
k = system equivalent resistance coefficient, dimensionless
ρ_m = flue gas density at mean temperature, kg/m^3
ρ_o = air density of ambient temperature, kg/m^3

From Equation (22), it is possible to develop a relationship for average frontal velocity, maximum chimney capacity, and variation of gas temperature with changes in fuel input rate.

Using resistance coefficients in these compact systems is preferable to the usual method of equivalent lengths. The summation term k in a vertical chimney is the total of four individual resistance factors:

- Acceleration k_a of ambient air to flue gas velocity, a constant value that must always be included in the total; $k_a = 1.0$
- Inlet loss coefficient k_i for fireplace configuration, including smoke shelf

Cone-type fireplaces	$k_i = 0.5$
Masonry (damper throat = 2 × flue area)	$k_i = 1.0$
Masonry (damper throat = flue area)	$k_i = 2.5$

- Chimney flue pipe friction k_c at a typical Reynolds number of 10 000 and roughness of 0.001, where r_h = hydraulic radius, m

$$k_c = 0.0083 \left(\frac{H}{r_h}\right)$$

- Termination coefficient k_t

For open top pipe or tile, same size as chimney	$k_t = 0$
Disk or cone cap at $D/2$ above outlet	$k_t = 0.5$
Manufactured caps	$k_t = 0$ to 4.0

For a 3.6 mhigh open top chimney, 300 mm in diameter on a typical fireplace, the system resistance is

k_a =	1.0
k_i =	2.5
$k_c = 0.0083(12/0.25)$ =	0.4
k_t =	0.0
	k = 3.9 summation

Note that in a short chimney, the wall friction coefficient k_c is only 0.4 and has a minor effect on system flow. Greater or lesser chimney roughness, or a change from low to high heat loss materials will have little bearing on fireplace effectiveness in short chimneys. In some situations, it may be necessary, for completeness, to include a k term for air supply resistance.

To determine the frontal velocity V_F of ambient air, the term w is replaced using the substitution

$$w = \rho_o A_F V_F \tag{23}$$

where

A_F = fireplace frontal opening area, m^2
V_F = fireplace mean frontal velocity, m/s

Accordingly, mean frontal velocity V_F becomes

$$V_F = \frac{A_c}{A_F}\left(\frac{2gH}{k}\right)^{1/2}\left[\frac{\rho_m(\rho_o - \rho_m)}{\rho_o}\right]^{1/2} \tag{24}$$

For present purposes, the relative molecular mass or density of dilute combustion products is practically the same as that of air, and

both can be expressed with adequate accuracy in terms of absolute gas temperature by the same relationship:

$$\rho_o = 3.48\frac{B_o}{T_o} \quad (25)$$

$$\rho_m = 3.48\frac{B_o}{T_m} \quad (26)$$

where

B_o = existing barometric pressure, kPa
T_o = ambient air temperature, K
T_m = mean combustion products temperature, K

Substitution of the density/temperature relationships (Equations [25] and [26]) into Equation (24) allows further simplification, leading to the general frontal velocity expression:

$$V_F = \frac{A_c}{A_F}\left(\frac{2gH}{k}\right)^{1/2}\frac{[T_o(T_m - T_o)]^{1/2}}{T_m} \quad (27)$$

Here, frontal velocity is a function of the product of three terms:

- Dimensionless area ratio A_c/A_F
- Height/resistance term $(2gH/k)^{1/2}$
- Dimensionless temperature effects $[T_o(T_m - T_o)]^{1/2}/T_m$

For the 3.6 m high example chimney, assume ambient temperature (for calculation purposes) is 21°C, or T_o = 294 K indoors and outdoors, with no air supply resistance. Equation (27) expresses variation in V_F with gas temperature as shown in Figure 17. Assume also A_c/A_F = 0.10, so that frontal opening is ten times chimney area.

The mean airflow velocity into a fireplace frontal opening is nearly constant from 165 K flue gas temperature rise up to any higher temperature. Local velocities vary within the opening. Depending on design, air typically enters horizontally along the hearth and then flows into the fire and upward, clinging to the back wall (see Figure 16). A recirculating eddy forms just inside the upper front half of the opening, induced by the high velocity of flow along the back. Restrictions or poor construction in the throat area between the lintel and damper also increase the eddy. Because the eddy moves smoke out of the zone of maximum velocity, the tendency of this smoke to escape must be counteracted by some minimum inward air movement over the entire front of the fireplace, particularly under the lintel.

Construction of a fireplace, its internal configuration, damper location, height and location of lintel, slope of back and sides, and so on all affect minimum frontal velocity to prevent smoking with ordinary fires. It seems desirable to maintain a smooth, gradual tapering transition between the hearth or flame region up into the damper location. A sudden transition, unless it is well above the lintel, induces velocity components that tend to increase eddying. With a shallow chamber between lintel and damper zone, there is insufficient volume for convection currents, and some flue gases may be diverted horizontally before being captured by the main flow. Masons following the dimensional parameters recommended by Ramsey and Sleeper (1956) or in damper literature can avoid these design flaws. With prefabricated fireplace systems, which often tend to be unconventional, careful testing is essential to ensure safe, smoke-free performance at minimum chimney height.

A minimum mean frontal inlet velocity of 0.244 m/s, in conjunction with a chimney flue gas temperature of at least 165 to 280 K above ambient, should control smoking in a well-constructed conventional masonry fireplace. As noted in Figure 17, this velocity can be achieved even in low chimneys by system resistance of 2.9 or less, in conjunction with rates of combustion producing flue gas temperatures above a certain minimum level.

Figure 17 also illustrates why increases in flue gas temperature rise greater than 165 K have no perceptible effect on fireplace smoking, because combustion air mass flow and face velocity actually

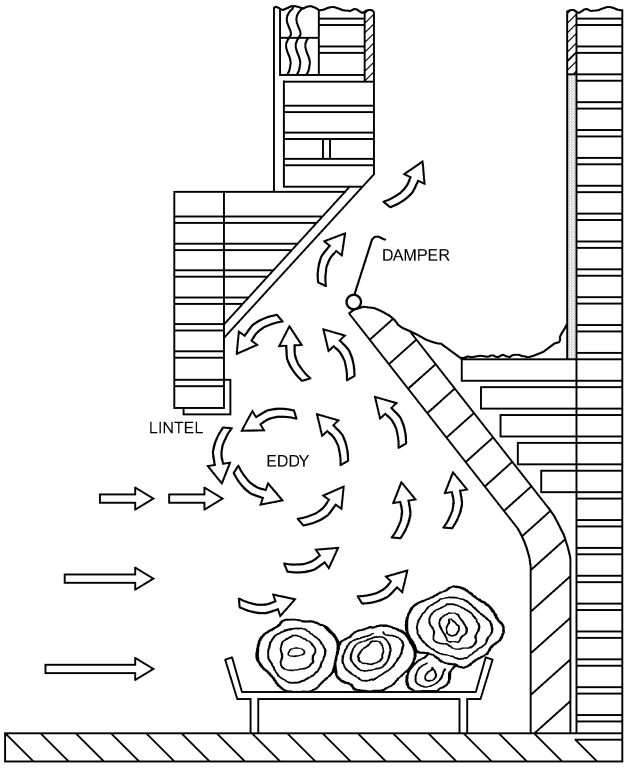


Fig. 16 Eddy Formation

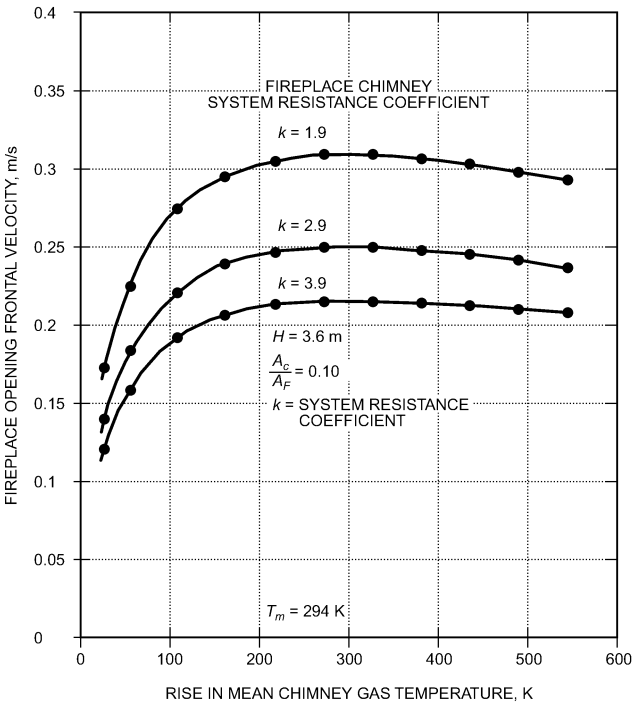


Fig. 17 Effect of Chimney Gas (Combustion Products) Temperature on Fireplace Frontal Opening Velocity

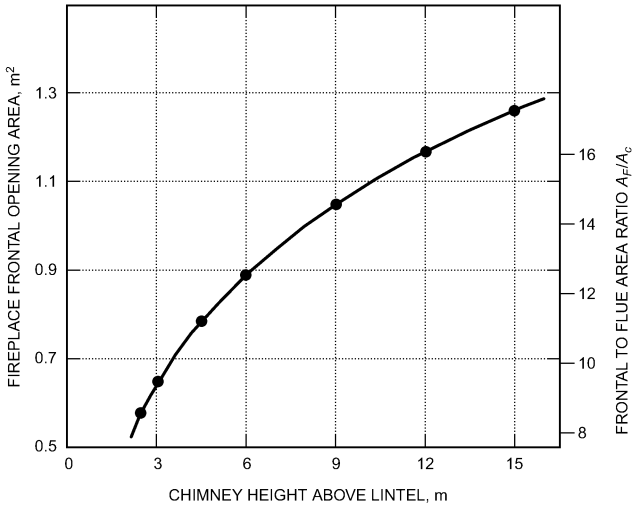


Fig. 18 Permissible Fireplace Frontal Opening Area for Design Conditions (0.24 m/s mean frontal velocity with 0.3 m inside diameter round flue)

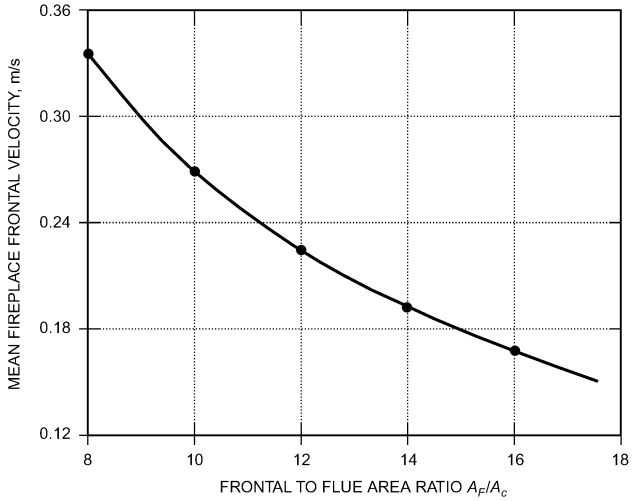


Fig. 19 Effect of Area Ratio on Frontal Velocity (for chimney height of 4.6 m with 0.3 m inside diameter round flue)

decrease at flue gas temperature rises higher than 280 K. For practical purposes, chimney flue gas temperature has little influence on fireplace performance, if flue gas temperature is at least 165 K above ambient. Fireplace performance analysis thus can be continued assuming a constant flue gas temperature of 280 K rise above ambient:

$$\frac{[T_o(T_m - T_o)]^{1/2}}{T_m} = 0.5$$

where $T_m = 572$ K and $T_o = 294$ K.

Assuming 21°C ambient (T_o = 294 K), and factoring out $2g$, Equation (27) becomes roughly

$$V_F = 2.21 \frac{A_c}{A_F}\left(\frac{H}{k}\right)^{1/2} \tag{28}$$

This expression states that relative fireplace performance is purely a matter of geometry. It allows evaluation of the opening size to maintain minimum frontal velocity as a function of height, as well as quick analysis of effect of frontal area on velocity.

Figure 18 shows that 0.24 m/s face velocity requires a relatively small A_F/A_c area ratio at 2.4 m chimney height, whereas the fireplace frontal opening area can be nearly twice as large with a 12 m high chimney. To compute this curve, system resistance is assumed as

$$k = 2.5 + 0.033H/D$$
$$D = 0.3 \text{ m diameter}$$

This expression of resistance assumes the fully open free area of the damper throat to be twice chimney flue area.

A corollary application of Equation (28) assumes fixed chimney size and height, and explores variation in frontal velocity with changes in area ratio. Figure 19 shows that a 0.3 m diameter, 4.6 m high chimney cannot produce adequate velocities for frontal area ratios greater than 11. These curves point out the possibility of further simplification to yield a fireplace-chimney design equation for a constant face velocity of 0.24 m/s.

$$A_F = 9.06Ac\left(\frac{H}{k}\right)^{1/2} \tag{29}$$

This equation allows permissible frontal area A_F to be determined as a function of chimney area, height, and system resistance. It can also be used to determine A_c, if A_F is known. However, in this latter case, Equations (30) and (31) are preferable, because chimney size (D_c, A_c, and R_h) appears twice in the right-hand side of each equation.

For circular flues,

$$A_F = 7.12\ D_c^2\left(\frac{H}{2.5 + 0.033\frac{H}{D_c}}\right)^{1/2} \tag{30}$$

For other flue shapes,

$$A_F = 9.06A_c\left(\frac{H}{2.5 + 0.0083\frac{H}{R_h}}\right)^{1/2} \tag{31}$$

where D_c is chimney inside diameter, m, R_h is inside hydraulic radius, m, frontal velocity V_F is 0.244 m/s at maximum combustion air mass flow rate, and damper opening free area is twice chimney flue area combustion air A_F.

These relationships clearly reveal the origin of rules of thumb specifying opening area as 8, 10, or 12 times chimney area. Some design guides go beyond and classify chimneys by height groups so that short ones serve smaller fireplace openings. Using a mean face velocity of 0.244 m/s yields ratios and heights that fall well within the limits of such rules, as well as providing a unifying concept for computing design charts.

The previous relationships primarily apply to masonry single-face fireplaces of conventional construction, but are applicable to other types with considerable validity if face or opening area is properly treated. Corner or double-face designs and many free-standing types embody conventional smokeshelf construction with similar resistance coefficients.

The preceding equations can be applied to illustrate the effect of excessive firing rates on chimney flue gas temperature. Masonry fireplaces are highly inefficient as heating devices, and tests show that, over a wide range of controlled fuel inputs using a drilled-port

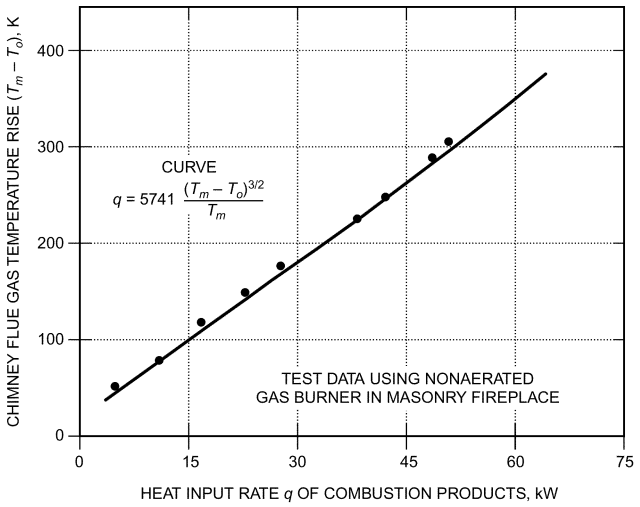


Fig. 20 Variation of Chimney Flue Gas Temperature with Heat Input Rate of Combustion Products

nonaerated gas burner, 75 to 80% of the gross heating value goes up the chimney. With constant flue heat loss of 80%, 70% of heat loss is sensible heat, which produces the rise in flue gas temperature. This heat input/temperature relationship may be developed by expressing the system flow relationship in terms of heat input:

$$w = \frac{q}{c_p(T_m - T_o)} \tag{32}$$

where

q = heat content of chimney flue gases, kW
c_p = specific heat of chimney gases, assumed to be approximately 1.046 kJ/(kg·K)

Equating Equations (32) and (22), and eliminating w,

$$\frac{q}{c_p(T_m - T_o)} = A_c \left(\frac{2gH}{k}\right)^{1/2} [\rho_m (\rho_o - \rho_m)]^{1/2} \tag{33}$$

Substituting Equations (25) and (26) for density and solving for q,

$$q = \frac{3.48 B_o A_c c_p}{(T_o)^{0.5}} \left(\frac{2gH}{k}\right)^{1/2} \frac{(T_m - T_o)^{3/2}}{T_m} \tag{34}$$

For any given system, all terms except $(T_m - T_o)^{3/2}/T_m$ may be considered fixed; therefore, gas temperature rise for a fireplace can be obtained as a concise function of heat input:

$$q = \overline{C} \frac{(T_m - T_o)^{1.5}}{T_m} \tag{35}$$

where $\overline{C}$ is a constant.

The flow-temperature function of a carefully controlled experimental fireplace (Equation [34] or [35]) in which $\overline{C}$ as fixed is plotted in Figure 20 as chimney flue gas temperature versus heat input rate. Data taken on a fireplace-chimney system in this way may readily be evaluated to determine system resistance coefficient k.

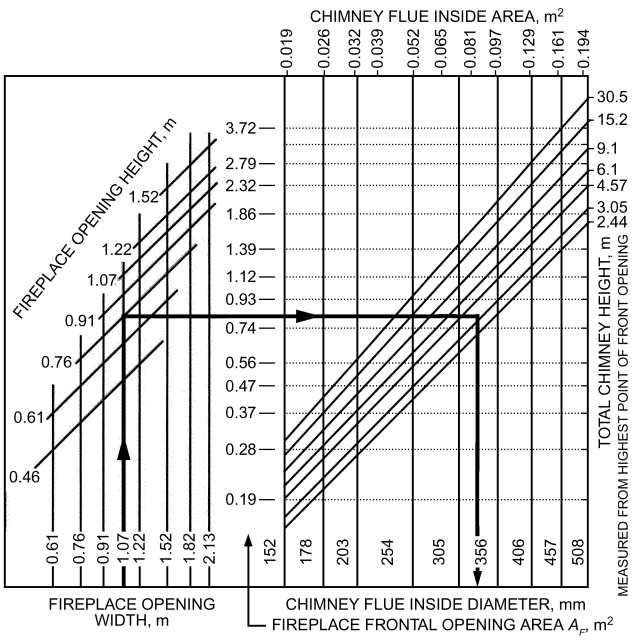


Fig. 21 Chimney Sizing Chart for Fireplaces

Mean face velocity = 0.244 m/s
(Stone 2005)

Figure 21 shows fireplace and chimney dimensions for the specific conditions of circular flues at 0.244 m/s frontal velocity. This chart solves readily for maximum frontal opening for a given chimney, as well as for chimney size and height with a predetermined opening. For example, a 1050 mm high by 750 mm wide opening for a 4 m high chimney (measured from the highest point of front opening) requires a 350 mm flue. Figure 21 assumes no wind or air supply difficulties. For other face velocities, A_F is found by multiplying frontal area (center scale) by velocity ratio $0.244/V_F$. To confirm the example results, calculate from Equation (30) as follows:

$$A_F = 7.12 \; D_c^2 \frac{H}{(2.5 + 0.033H)/D_c}^{1/2}$$

where H is 44 m and D_c is 0.35 m.

$$A_F = 0.788 \text{ m}^2 = 0.75 \text{ m} \times 1.05 \text{ m}$$

Although derived specifically for circular flues, A_F applies with negligible sacrifice in performance to chimney flue cross sections such as squared or rounded ovals, because flue area is a much more important factor than friction caused by changes in hydraulic radius. For example, in a 6.1 m high chimney, assuming a square flue section equal in area to a 203 mm circle, frontal area is reduced from 0.386 m² with the round, to 0.380 m² with the square, or about 2%, a difference that is hardly observable. For some typical constructions, Figure 22 suggests methods of estimating frontal area.

These relationships apply to steady-state conditions, which are obtained only after warm-up. Igniting a rapidly flammable charge in a cold system creates pulses of expanding hot combustion products, which frequently escape from the fireplace. In a typical chimney, priming time (time to accelerate from no flow to full upward velocity) is around 5 to 10 s. Thus, initial or intermittent smoking caused by momentarily excessive combustion rates occurs because of system inability to increase flue gas velocity in pace with combustion surges.

Flue or chimney material is of little relevance to fireplace-chimney operation. Materials to which these equations and charts apply

include the very hazardous uninsulated single-wall metal, through conventional masonry, as well as the various constructions of lightweight, insulated, factory-built low-heat-space-appliance chimneys. (Safety standards classify fireplaces as low-heat appliances.) Because most fireplace chimneys are short and vertical, neither heat loss nor wall roughness has any important effect on flow. The governing factors in chimney selection for fireplaces are mainly safety, installation, convenience, and esthetics.

Indoor/outdoor pressure differences caused by winds, kitchen or bath exhaust fans, building stack effects, and operation of forced-air heating systems or mechanical ventilation affect the operation of a fireplace. Thus, smoking during start-up can be caused by factors unrelated to the chimney. Frequently, in new homes (especially in high-rise multiple-family construction), fireplaces of normal design cannot cope with mechanically induced reverse flow or shortages of combustion air. In these circumstances, a fireplace should include an induced-draft blower able to overpower other mechanized air-consuming systems. An inducer for this purpose is best located at the chimney outlet and should produce 0.244 to 0.305 m/s fireplace face velocity of ambient air in an individual flue or 3.05 to 3.66 m/s chimney velocity.

In conventional fireplaces, the greater the frontal velocity, the more freedom from smoking. The damper free area, together with its resultant resistance coefficient, are thus major factors in obtaining good masonry fireplace performance, especially with short chimneys. Tests show that damper free area need not exceed twice the required flue area, because little further resistance reduction occurs past this limit.

If the damper selected has a free area equal to or less than the required area, it will be definitely restrictive, despite complete adequacy of other factors. Manufacturers' literature seldom includes damper free area or opening dimensions, and the dimensions may vary further after installation because of interferences with lintels and other parts. It is expedient to select dampers of adequate free area for best results.

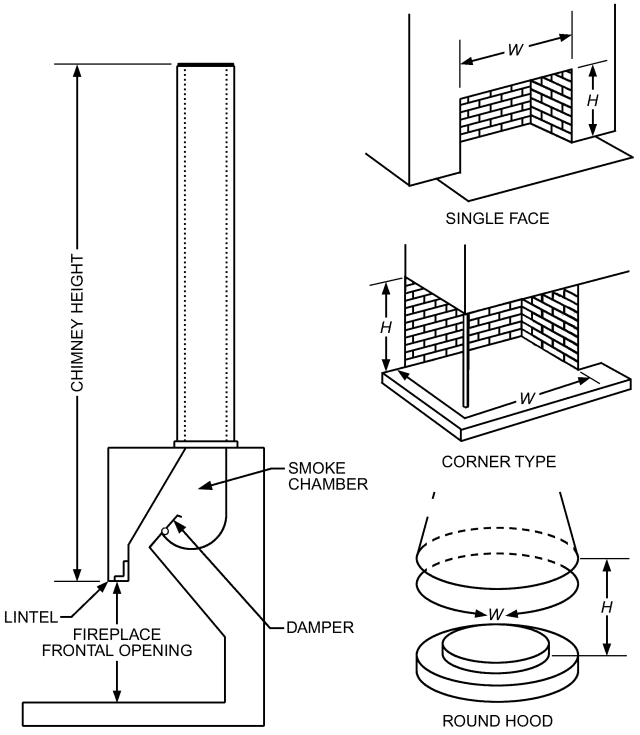


Fig. 22 Estimation of Fireplace Frontal Opening Area

Partially closing a damper during a vigorous fire illustrates this point; what is not so obvious is that greater damper openings may be needed in some cases to control smoke by achieving adequate frontal velocities.

Many free-standing fireplaces are built without the usual smokeshelf/throat damper configuration. The same parameters and relationships apply to free-standing fireplaces as to masonry fireplaces; however, in many designs it is difficult to assign a true frontal area for velocity analysis. Where freestanding fireplaces include back outlets, or require a horizontal run to reach the chimney, compensation is necessary for the flow resistance or pressure losses caused by turns. As a rough approximation, increase the system resistance coefficient k about 1.5 for two 90° elbows, or a back outlet with lateral run into a tee.

Losses caused by lateral connectors and tees generally mean a one-size increase (e.g., moving from 150 to 200) is sufficient. Collar sizes generally determine correct chimney size, and instructions are furnished to cover special situations. More sophisticated prefabricated fireplace designs are provided with matching correctly sized chimneys, and are intended for installation in conventional wood-frame residences.

The equations and design charts presented here assume no wind or air supply difficulties. Lack of replacement air, competing ventilation exhaust fans, and negative interior pressures caused by winds are all obvious causes of smoking or poor fireplace priming. Even when fully primed and hot, thermal forces in a fireplace chimney can be overpowered by a combination of adverse influences. In modern high-rise residential apartments, where an effort has been made to provide all amenities, fireplaces may have to cope simultaneously with all these troubles. Continuous induced draft for the chimney alleviates most of these problems by maintaining a chimney prime at all times. An inducer for this purpose should be able to produce 0.24 to 0.30 m/s fireplace frontal velocity of ambient air in any individual flue. Where multiple flues are installed in a chase, a single, larger inducer serving the chase can be sized for the combined fireplace frontal opening area. Even where flues are of different heights and sizes, a draft inducer selection, assuming all flues to be some compromise median height and size, produces far greater user satisfaction than reliance on gravity alone.

In single-family dwellings, fireplace problems are more often caused by reduced interior pressures from wind effects than by poor chimney terminal location or characteristics. Efforts to cure smoking, slow priming, or blowback of ashes usually involve one of the myriad forms of stationary or rotating caps, cowls, or chimney pots. This questionable expedient has contradictory effects. Usually, the added still-air resistance of a cap reduces fireplace frontal velocity, which limits combustion airflow rate, and thus may tend to increase smoking. On the other hand, a cap reduces air dilution of smaller fires, raises chimney temperature, and improves stability of flame, thus tending to mitigate wind impulses that cause momentary flow reduction. The usual fireplace damper can also be used to restrict flow, and thus raise temperature.

Remedies for fireplace malfunctions may be analyzed using Equation (28). For example, it is apparent that any change of parameters on the right-hand side that might decrease V_F can increase smoking tendencies. If frontal area A_F or k increases, there will be a corresponding decrease in V_F. Similarly, if chimney area A_c or chimney height H are reduced, then V_F decreases. Further, because frontal velocity varies as the square root of the term H/k, it is more effective to reduce frontal area, thereby increasing A_c/A_F, than to increase H or reduce k.

Logical expedients for increasing V_F frontal velocity, and thus improving performance of fireplaces and chimneys, include the following:

- Increase chimney height (using the same flue area) and extend the last tile 150 mm upward, or more.
- Decrease frontal opening by lowering the lintel, or raising the hearth. (Glass doors may help by increasing V_F.)
- Increase free area through damper. (Check that it opens fully without interferences.)

CSA *Standard* P.4.1-02 can be used for measuring annual efficiency in Canada.

10. AIR SUPPLY TO FUEL-BURNING APPLIANCES

Failure to supply outdoor air for combustion may result in erratic or even dangerous operating conditions. A correctly designed gas appliance with a draft hood can function with short vents (1.5 m high) using an outdoor air supply opening as small in area as the vent outlet collar. Such an orifice, when equal to vent area, has a resistance coefficient in the range of 2 to 3. If the air supply opening is as much as twice the vent area, however, the coefficient drops to 0.5 or less.

The following rules may be used as a guide:

- Residential heating appliances installed in unconfined spaces in buildings of conventional construction do not ordinarily require ventilation other than normal air infiltration. In any residence or building that has been built or altered to conserve energy or minimize infiltration, the heating appliance area should be considered a confined space. The air supply should be installed in accordance with NFPA *Standard* 54/AGA Z223.1, CSA *Standard* B149.1, or the following recommendations.
- Residential heating appliances installed in a confined space having unusually tight construction require two permanent openings to an unconfined space or to the outdoors. An unconfined space has a volume of at least 4.8 m^3 per kilowatt (m^3 per kJ/s) of the total input rating of all appliances installed in that space. Free opening areas must be greater than 550 mm^2 per kilowatt input with vertical ducts or 1100 mm^2 per kilowatt with horizontal ducts to the outdoors. The two openings communicating directly with sufficient unconfined space must be greater than 2200 mm^2 per kilowatt. Upper openings should be within 300 mm of the ceiling; lower openings should be within 300 mm of the floor.
- Complete combustion of natural and propane gas or fuel oil requires approximately 0.27 m^3 of air, at standard conditions, for each megajoule of fuel burned, but excess air is usually required for proper burner operation.
- The size of these air openings may be modified if special engineering ensures an adequate supply of air for combustion, dilution, and ventilation or if local ordinances apply to boiler and machinery rooms.
- In calculating free area of air inlets, consider the blocking effect of louvers, grilles, or screens protecting openings. Screens should not be smaller than 6.4 mm mesh. If the free area through a particular louver or grille is known, use that in calculating the size opening required to provide the free area specified. If the free area is not known, assume that wood louvers have 20 to 25% free area and metal louvers and grilles have 60 to 75% free area.
- Mechanical ventilation systems serving the fuel-burning appliance room or adjacent spaces should not be allowed to create negative appliance room air pressure. The appliance room may require tight self-closing doors and provisions to supply air to spaces under negative pressure so fuel-burning appliances and venting operate properly.
- Fireplaces may require special consideration. For example, a residential attic fan can be hazardous if it is inadvertently turned on while a fireplace is in use.
- In buildings where large quantities of combustion and ventilation or process air are exhausted, a sufficient supply of fresh uncontaminated makeup air, warmed if necessary to the proper temperature, should be provided. It is good practice to provide about 5 to 10% more makeup air than the amount exhausted.

11. VENT AND CHIMNEY MATERIALS

Factors to be considered when selecting chimney materials include (1) the temperature of flue gases; (2) their composition and propensity for condensation of water vapor from combustion products (dew point); (3) presence of sulfur, halogens, and other fuel and air contaminants that lead to corrosion of the chimney vent system; and (4) the appliance's operating cycle (condensate dwell time).

Materials for vents and chimneys in the 100 to 1220 mm size range include single-wall metal, various multiwall air- and mass-insulated types, and precast and site-constructed masonry. Each has different characteristics (e.g., frequency of joints, roughness, heat loss), but the type of materials used for systems 360 mm and larger is relatively unimportant in determining draft or capacity. This does not preclude selecting a safe product or method of construction that minimizes heat loss and fire hazard in the building.

National codes and standards classify heat-producing appliances as low, medium, and high heat, with appropriate reference to chimney and vent constructions permitted with each. These classifications are mainly based on size, process use, or combustion temperature. Often, the appliance classification gives little information about outlet gas temperature or venting needed. The designer should, wherever possible, obtain gas outlet temperature conditions and properties that apply to the specific appliance, rather than going by code classification only.

Where building codes allow engineered chimney systems, chimney material selection based on gas outlet temperature can save space as well as reduce structural and material costs. For example, in some jurisdictions, approved gas-burning appliances with draft hoods operating at inputs over 117 kW (kJ/s) may be placed in a heat-producing classification that prohibits use of type B gas vents. An increase in input may not cause an increase in outlet temperature or in venting hazards, and most building codes recommend correct matching appliance and vent.

Single-wall uninsulated steel stacks can be protected from condensation and corrosion internally with refractory firebrick liners or by spraying calcium aluminate cement over a suitable interior expanded metal mesh or other reinforcement. Another form of protection applies proprietary silica or other prepared refractory coatings to pins or a support mesh on the steel. The material must then be suitably cured for moisture and heat resistance.

Moisture condensation on interior surfaces of connectors, vents, stacks, and chimneys is a more serious cause of deterioration than heat. Chimney wall temperature and flue gas velocity, temperature, and dew point affect condensation. Contaminants such as sulfur, chlorides, and fluorides in the fuel and combustion air raise the flue gas dew point. Studies by Beaumont et al. (1970), Mueller (1968), Pray et al. (1942-53), and Yeaw and Schnidman (1943) indicate the variety of analytical methods as well as difficulties in predicting the causes and probability of actual condensation.

Combustion products from any fuel containing hydrogen condense onto cold surfaces or condense in bulk if the main flow of flue gas is cooled sufficiently. Because flue gas loses heat through walls, condensation occurs first on interior wall surfaces cooled to the flue gas dew point, forming a dew and then a liquid film and, with further cooling, flowing down into zones where condensation would not normally occur.

Start-up of cold interior chimney surfaces is accompanied by transient dew formation, which evaporates on heating above the dew point. This phenomenon causes little corrosion when very low

sulfur fuels are used. Proper selection of chimney dimensions and materials minimizes condensation and thus corrosion.

Experience shows a correlation between the sulfur content of the fuel and the deterioration of interior chimney surfaces. Figure 5 in Chapter 28 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* illustrates one case, which applies to any fuel gas. The figure shows that the flue gas dew point increases at 40% excess air from 53°C with zero sulfur to 71°C with 16.75 mg of sulfur per megajoule of fuel having a heat value of 20.49 MJ/m^3.

The figure can also be used to approximate the effect of fuel oil sulfur content on flue gas dew point. For example, fuel oil with a sulfur content of 0.5% (by mass) contains about of sulfur per gallon or 4.31 kg of sulfur per cubic metre of fuel. If the fuel heat value is 559 kJ/m^3, the ratio that defines the curves in the figure gives a curve value of 111. Estimates for lower percentages of sulfur (0.25, 0.05) can be formed as factors of the value 111.

Because the corrosion mechanism is not completely understood, judicious use of resistant materials, suitably insulated or jacketed to reduce heat loss, is preferable to low-cost single-wall construction. Refractory materials and mortars should be acid-resistant, and steels should be resistant to sulfuric, hydrochloric, and hydrofluoric acids; pitting; and oxidation. Where low flue gas temperatures are expected together with low ambients, an air space jacket or mineral fiber lagging, suitably protected against water entry, helps maintain surface and flue gas temperatures above the dew point. Using low-sulfur fuel, which is required in many localities, reduces both corrosion and air pollution.

Type 1100 aluminum alloy or any other non-copper-bearing aluminum alloy of 99% purity or better provides satisfactory performance in prefabricated metal gas vent products. For chimney service, flue gas temperatures from appliances burning oil or solid fuels may exceed the melting point of aluminum; therefore, steel is required. Stainless steels such as type 430 or 304 give good service in residential construction and are referenced in UL-listed prefabricated chimneys. Where more corrosive substances (e.g., high-sulfur fuel or chlorides from solid fuel, contaminated air, refuse) are anticipated, type AL 29-4CR® or equivalent stainless steel offers a good match of corrosion resistance and mechanical properties.

As an alternative to stainless steel, porcelain enamel offers good resistance to corrosion if two coats of acid-resistant enamel are used on all surfaces. A single coat, which always has imperfections, allows base metal corrosion, spalling, and early failure.

Prefabricated chimneys and venting products are available that use light corrosion-resistant materials, both in metal and masonry. The standardized, prefabricated, double-wall metal type B gas vent has an aluminum inner pipe and a coated steel outer casing, either galvanized or aluminized. Standard air space from 6.35 to 12.7 mm is adequate for applicable tests and a wide variety of exposures.

Air-insulated all-metal chimneys are available for low-heat use in residential construction. Thermosiphon air circulation or multiple reflective shielding with three or more walls keeps these units cool. Insulated, double-wall residential chimneys are also available. The annulus between metal inner and outer walls is filled with insulation and retained by coupler end structures for rapid assembly.

Prefabricated, air-insulated, double-wall metal chimneys for multifamily residential and larger buildings, classed as building heating appliance chimneys, are available (Figure 23). Refractory-lined prefabricated chimneys (medium-heat type) are also available for this use.

Commercial and industrial incinerators, as well as heating appliances, may be vented by prefabricated metal-jacketed cast refractory chimneys, which are listed in the medium-heat category and are suitable for intermittent flue gas temperatures to 1100°C. All prefabricated chimneys and vents carrying a listing by a recognized testing laboratory have been evaluated for class of service regarding temperature, strength, clearance to adjacent combustible materials, and suitability of construction in accordance with applicable national standards.

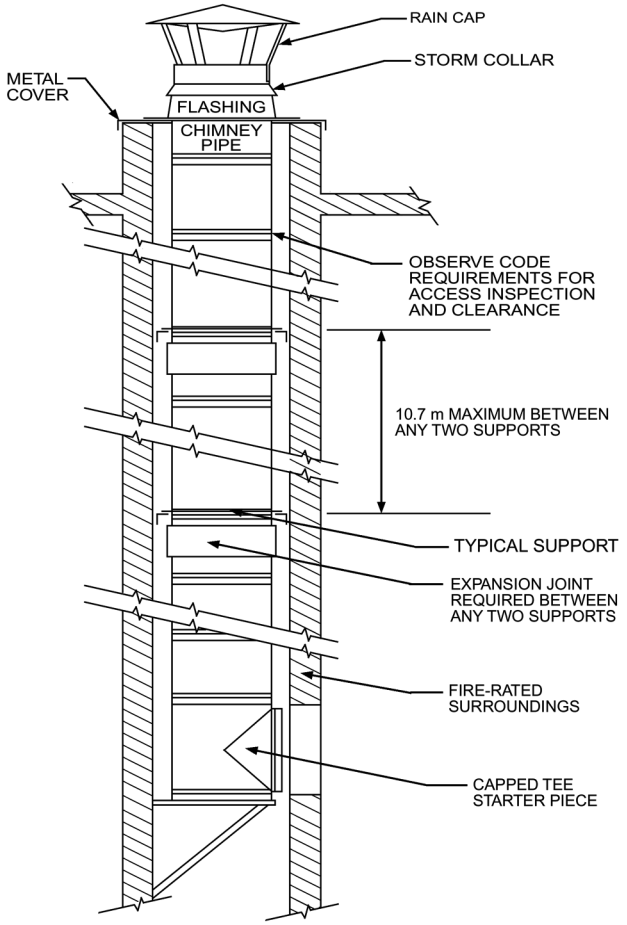


Fig. 23 Building Heating Appliance, Medium-Heat Chimney

Table 10 Underwriters Laboratories Test Standards

No.	Subject	Steady-State Appliance Flue Gas Temperature Rise, °F	Fuel
103	Chimneys, factory-built, residential type (includes building heating appliances)	517	All
127	Fireplaces, factory-built	517	Solid or gas
311	Roof jacks for manufactured homes and recreational vehicles	517	Oil, gas
378	Draft equipment (such as regulators and inducers)	—	All
441	Gas vents (type B, BW)	267	Gas only
641	Low-temperature venting systems (type L)	278	Oil, gas
959	Chimneys, factory-built, medium-heat	961	All
1738	Venting systems for gas-burning appliances, categories II, III, and IV	78 to 267	Gas only

Underwriters Laboratories (UL) standards, listed in Table 10, describe the construction and temperature testing of various classes of prefabricated vent and chimney materials. Standards for some related parts and appliances are also included in Table 10 because a listed factory-built fireplace, for example, must be used with a specified type of factory-built chimney. The temperature given for the steady-state operation of chimneys is the lowest in the test sequence. Factory-built chimneys under UL *Standard* 103 are also required to demonstrate adequate safety during a 1 h test at 740 K rise and to withstand a 10 min simulated soot burnout at either 906 or 1128 K rise.

These product tests determine minimum clearance to combustible surfaces or enclosures, based on allowable temperature rise on combustibles. They also ensure that the supports, spacers, and parts of the product that contact combustible materials remain at safe temperatures during operation. Product markings and installation instructions of listed materials are required to be consistent with test results, refer to types of appliances that may be used, and explain structural and other limitations.

12. VENT AND CHIMNEY ACCESSORIES

Vent or chimney system design must consider the existence of or need for accessories such as draft diverters, draft regulators, induced-draft fans, blocking dampers, expansion joints, and vent or chimney terminals. Draft regulators include barometric draft regulators and furnace sequence draft controls, which monitor automatic flue dampers during operation. The design, materials, and flow losses of chimney and vent connectors are covered in previous sections.

Draft Hoods

The draft hood isolates the appliance from venting disturbances (updrafts, downdrafts, or blocked vent) and allows combustion to start without venting action. Suggested general dimensions of draft hoods are given in ANSI *Standard* Z21.12, which describes certification test methods for draft hoods. In general, the pipe size of the inlet and outlet flues of the draft hood should be the same as that of the appliance outlet connection. The vent connection at the draft hood outlet should have a cross-sectional area at least as large as that of the draft hood inlet.

Draft hood selection comes under the following two categories:

- **Those supplied with a design-certified gas appliance:** certification of a gas appliance design under pertinent national standards includes its draft hood (or draft diverter). Consequently, the draft hood should not be altered or replaced without consulting the manufacturer and local code authorities.
- **Those supplied separately for gas appliances:** listed draft hoods for existing vent or chimney connectors should be installed by experienced installers in accordance with accepted practice standards.

Every design-certified gas appliance requiring a draft hood must be accompanied by a draft hood or provided with a draft diverter as an integral part of the appliance. The draft hood is a vent inlet fitting as well as a safety device for the appliance, and assumptions can be made regarding its interaction with a vent. First, when the hood is operating without spillage, the heat content of flue gases (enthalpy relative to dilution air temperature) leaving the draft hood is almost the same as that entering. Second, safe operation is obtained with 40 to 50% dilution air. It is unnecessary to assume 100% dilution air for gas venting conditions. Third, during certification tests, the draft hood must function without spillage, using a vent with not over 1.5 m of effective height and one or two elbows. Therefore, if vent heights appreciably greater than 1.5 m are used, an individual vent of the same size as the draft hood outlet may be much larger than necessary.

When vent size is reduced, as with tall vents, draft hood resistance is less than design value relative to the vent; the vent tables in the *National Fuel Gas Code* (NFPA *Standard* 54/AGA Z223.1) give adequate guidance for such size reductions.

Despite its importance as a vent inlet fitting, the draft hood designed for a typical gas appliance primarily represents a compromise of the many design criteria and tests solely applicable to that appliance. This allows considerable variation in resistance loss; thus, catalog data on draft hood resistance loss coefficients do not exist. The span of draft hood loss coefficients, including inlet acceleration, varies from the theoretical minimum of 1.0 for certain low-loss bell or conical shapes to 3 or 4, where the draft hood relief opening is located within a hot-air discharge (as with wall furnaces) and high resistance is needed to limit sensible heat loss into the vent.

Draft hoods must not be used on appliances having draft configuration 1 or 3 (see conditions 1, 2, and 3 under Terminology and Table 8) that is operated with either power burners or forced venting, unless the appliances have fan-assisted burners that overcome some or most of the appliance flow resistance and create a pressure inversion ahead of the draft hood or barometric regulator.

Gas appliances with draft hoods must have excess chimney draft capacity to draw in adequate draft hood dilution air. Failure to provide adequate combustion air can cause oxygen depletion and spillage of flue gases and flame rollout from the combustion air inlet at the burner(s).

Draft Regulators

Appliances requiring draft at the appliance flue gas outlet generally use barometric regulators for combustion stability. A balanced hinged gate in these devices bleeds air into the chimney automatically when pressure decreases. This action simultaneously increases vent gas flow and reduces temperature. Well-designed barometric regulators provide constant flue gas static pressure over a span of impressed vent gas draft (i.e., the draft that would exist without regulation) of about 50 Pa. A regulator can maintain 15 Pa draft for impressed drafts from 15 to 65 Pa. If the chimney system is very high or otherwise capable of generating available draft in excess of the pressure span capability of a single regulator, additional or oversize regulators may be used. Figure 24 shows proper locations for regulators in a chimney manifold.

Barometric regulators are available with double-acting dampers, which also swing out to relieve momentary internal pressures or divert continuing downdrafts. In the case of downdrafts, temperature safety switches actuated by hot gases escaping at the regulator sense and limit malfunctions.

Vent Dampers

Electrically, mechanically, and thermally actuated automatic vent dampers can reduce energy consumption and improve seasonal efficiency of gas- and oil-burning appliances. Vent dampers reduce loss of heated air through gas appliance draft hoods and loss of specific heat from the appliance after the burner stops firing. These dampers may be retrofit devices or integral components of some appliances.

Electrically and mechanically actuated dampers must open before main burner gas ignition and must not close during burner operation. These safety interlocks, which electrically interconnect with existing control circuitry, may include an additional main control valve or special gas-pressure-actuated controls.

Vent dampers that are thermally actuated with bimetallic elements and have spillage-sensing interlocks with burner controls are available for draft hood-type gas appliances. These dampers open in response to gas temperature after burner ignition. Because thermally actuated dampers may exhibit some flow resistance, even at equilibrium operating conditions, carefully follow instructions regarding allowable heat input and minimum required vent or chimney height.

Take special care to ensure that safety interlocks with appliance controls are installed according to instructions. Spillage-free gas venting after the damper has been installed must be verified with all damper types.

Energy savings of a vent damper can vary widely. Dampers reduce energy consumption under one or a combination of the following conditions:

- Heating appliance is oversized.
- Chimney is too high or oversized.
- Appliance is located in heated space.
- Two or more appliances are on the same chimney (a damper must be installed on each appliance connected to that chimney).
- Appliance is located in building zone at higher pressure than outdoors. This positive pressure can cause steady flow losses through the chimney.

Energy savings may not justify the cost of installing a vent damper if one or more of the following conditions exist:

- All combustion and ventilation air is supplied from outdoors to direct-vent appliances or to appliances located in an isolated, unheated room.
- Appliance is in an unheated basement that is isolated from the heated space.
- A one-story flat-roof house has a short vent, which is unlikely to carry away a significant amount of heated air.

For vents or chimneys serving two or more appliances, dampers (if used) should be installed on all attached appliances for maximum effectiveness. If only one damper is installed in such systems, loss of heated air through an open draft hood may negate a large portion of the potential energy savings.

Heat Exchangers or Flue Gas Heat Extractors

Sensible heat available in flue gas of properly adjusted furnaces burning oil or gas is about 10 to 15% of the rated input. Small accessory heat exchangers that fit in the connector between the appliance outlet and the chimney can recover some of this heat for localized use; however, they may cause some adverse effects.

All gas vent and chimney size or capacity tables assume the gas temperature or heat available to create theoretical draft is not reduced by a heat transfer device. In addition, the tables assume flow resistance for connectors, vents, and chimneys, comprising typical values for draft hoods, elbows, tees, caps, and piping with no allowance for added devices placed directly in the flue gas stream. Thus, heat exchangers or flue gas extractors should offer no flow resistance or negligible resistance coefficients when they are installed.

A heat exchanger that is reasonably efficient and offers some flow resistance may adversely affect the system by reducing both flow rate and flue gas temperature. This may cause moisture condensation in the chimney, draft hood spillage, or both. Increasing heat transfer efficiency increases the probability of the simultaneous occurrence of both effects. An accessory heat exchanger in a solid-fuel system, especially a wood stove or heater, may collect creosote or cause its formation downstream.

Retrofitting heat exchangers in gas appliance venting systems requires careful evaluation of heat recovered versus both installed cost and the potential for chimney safety and operating problems. Every heat exchanger installation should undergo the same spillage tests given a damper installation. In addition, the flue gas temperature should be checked to ensure it is high enough to avoid condensation between the exchanger outlet and the chimney outlet.

13. DRAFT FANS

The selection of draft fans, blowers, or inducers must consider (1) types and combinations of appliances, (2) types of venting material, (3) building and safety codes, (4) control circuits, (5) gas temperature, (6) permissible location, (7) noise, and (8) power cost. Besides specially designed fans and blowers, some conventional fans can be used if the wheel and housing materials are heat- and corrosion-resistant and if blower and motor bearings are protected from adverse effects of the flue gas stream.

Small draft inducers for residential gas appliance and unit heater use are available with direct-drive blower wheels and an integral device to sense flow (Figure 25A). The control circuit for these applications must provide adequate vent gas flow both before and while fuel flows to the main burner. Other types of small inducers are either saddle-mounted blower wheels (Figure 25B) or venturi ejectors that induce flow by jet action (Figure 25C). An essential safety requirement for inducers serving draft hood gas appliances does not permit appliance interconnections on the discharge or outlet side of the inducer. This requirement prevents backflow through an inoperative appliance.

With prefabricated sheet metal venting products such as type B gas vents, the vent draft inducer should be located at or downstream from the point the vent exits the building. This placement keeps the indoor system below atmospheric pressure and prevents flue gas from escaping through seams and joints. If the inducer cannot be placed on the roof or outdoor wall, metal joints must be reliably sealed in all pressurized parts of the system.

Pressure capability of residential draft inducers is usually less than 250 Pa at rated flow. Larger inducers of the fan, blower, or ejector type have greater pressure capability and may be used to reduce

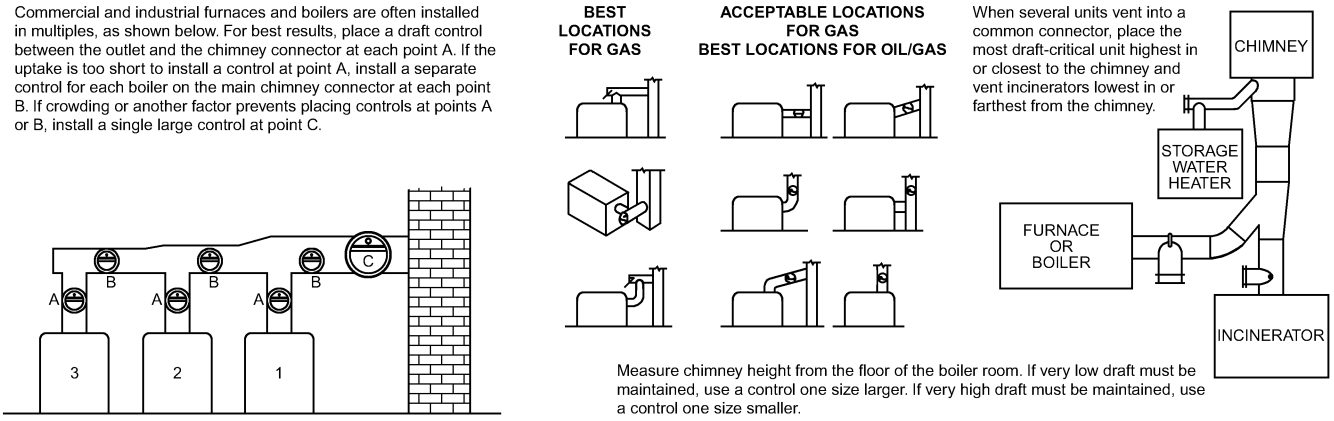


Fig. 24 Use of Barometric Draft Regulators

system size as well as supplement available draft. Figure 25D shows a specialized axial-flow fan capable of higher pressures. This unit is structurally self-supporting and can be mounted in any position in the connector or stack because the motor is in a well, separated from the flue gas stream. A right-angle fan, as shown in Figure 25E, is supported by an external bracket and adapts to several inlet and exit combinations. The unit uses the developed draft and an insulated tube to cool the extended shaft and bearings.

Pressure, volume, and power curves should be obtained to match an inducer to the application. For example, in an individual chimney system (without draft hood) in which a directly connected inducer only handles combustion products, calculation of the power required for continuous operation need only consider volume at operating flue gas temperature. An inducer serving multiple, separately controlled draft hood gas appliances must be powered for ambient temperature operation at full flow volume in the system. At any input, the inducer for a draft hood gas appliance must handle about 50% more standard chimney gas volume than a directly connected inducer. At constant volume with a given size inducer or fan, these demands follow the Fan Laws (see Chapter 21) applicable to power venting as follows:

- Pressure difference developed is directly proportional to gas density.
- Pressure difference developed is inversely proportional to absolute gas temperature.
- Pressure developed diminishes in direct proportion to drop in absolute atmospheric pressure, as with altitude.
- Required power is directly proportional to gas density.
- Required power is inversely proportional to absolute gas temperature.

Centrifugal and propeller draft inducers in vents and chimneys are applied and installed the same as in any heat-carrying duct system. Venturi ejector draft boosters involve some added consideration. An advantage of the ejector is that motor, bearings, and blower blades are outside the contaminated flue gas stream, thus eliminating a major source of deterioration. This advantage causes some loss of efficiency and can lead to reduced capacity because undersized systems, having considerable resistance downstream, may be unable to handle the added volume of the injected airstream without loss of performance. Ejectors are best suited for use at the chimney or vent exit or where there is an adequately sized chimney or vent to carry the combined discharge.

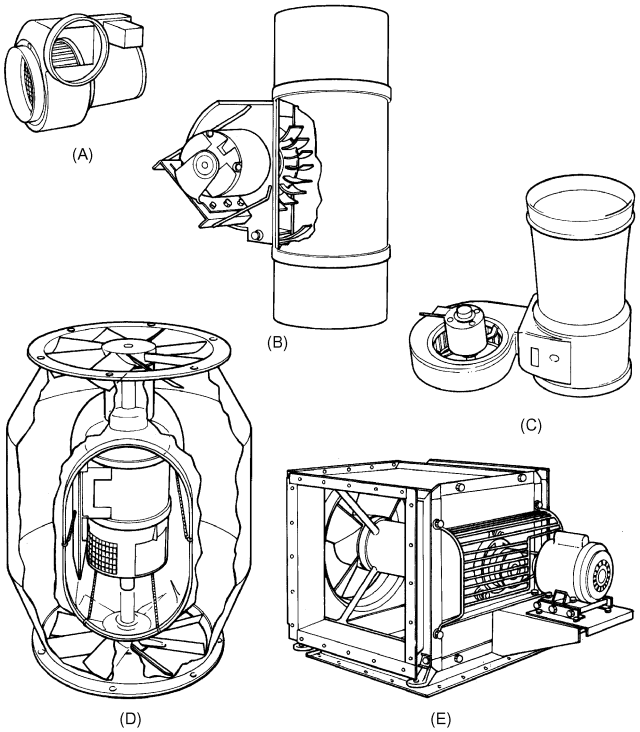


Fig. 25 Draft Inducers

If total pressure defines outlet conditions or is used for fan selection, the relative amounts of static pressure and velocity pressure must be factored out; otherwise, the velocity head method of calculation does not apply. To factor total pressure into its two components, either the discharge velocity in an outlet of known area or the flow rate must be known. For example, if an appliance or blower produces a total pressure of 67 Pa at 7.6 m/s discharge velocity and the velocity pressure calculates to 35 Pa at ambient standard conditions, then static pressure is 62 – 35 = 27 Pa. Because this static pressure is part of the system driving force, it combines with theoretical draft to overcome losses in the system.

Draft inducer fans can be operated either continuously or on demand. In either case, a safety switch that senses flue gas flow or pressure is needed to interrupt burner controls if adequate draft fails. Demand operation links the thermostat with the draft control motor. Once flow starts, as sensed with a flow or pressure switch, the burner is allowed to start. A single draft inducer, operating continuously, can be installed in the common vent of a system serving several separately controlled appliances. This simplifies the circuitry because only one control is needed to sense loss of draft. However, the single fan increases appliance standby loss (especially in boilers) and heat losses via ambient air drawn through inoperative appliances.

14. TERMINATIONS: CAPS AND WIND EFFECTS

The vent or chimney height and method of termination is governed by a variety of considerations, including fire hazard; wind effects; entry of rain, debris, and birds; and operating considerations such as draft and capacity. For example, the 0.9 m height required for residential chimneys above a roof is necessary so that small sparks will burn out before they fall on the roof shingles.

Many vent and chimney malfunctions are attributed to interactions of the chimney termination or its cap with winds acting on the roof or with adjoining buildings, trees, or mountains. Because winds fluctuate, no simple method of analysis or reduction to practice exists for this complex situation. Figures 26 to 28 show some of the complexities of wind flow contours around simple structural shapes.

Figure 26 shows three zones with differing degrees of flue gas dispersion around a rectangular building: the cavity or eddy zone, the wake zone, and the undisturbed flow zone (Clarke 1967). In addition, a fourth flow zone of intense turbulence is located downwind of the cavity. Chimney flue gases discharged into the wind at a point close to the roof surface in the cavity zone may be recirculated locally. Higher in the cavity zone, wind eddies can carry more dilute flue gas to the lee side of the building. Flue gases discharged into the wind in the wake zone do not recirculate into the immediate vicinity, but may soon descend to ground level. Above the wake zone, dispersal into the undisturbed wind flow carries and dilutes the flue gases over a wider area. The boundaries of these zones vary with building configuration and wind direction and turbulence; they are strongly influenced by surroundings.

The possibility of air pollutants reentering the cavity zone because of plume spread or of air pollution intercepting downwind cavities associated with adjacent structures or downwind buildings should be considered. Thus, the design criterion of elevating the stack discharge above the cavity is not valid for all cases. Consult a

meteorologist experienced with dispersion processes near buildings for complex cases and for cases involving air contaminants.

As chimney height increases through the three zones, draft performance improves dispersion, while additional problems of gas cooling, condensation, and structural wind load are created. As building height increases (Figure 27), the eddy forming the cavity zone no longer descends to ground level. For a low, wide building (Figure 28), wind blowing parallel to the long roof dimension can reattach to the surface; thus, the eddy zone becomes flush with the roof surface (Evans 1957). For satisfactory dispersion with low, wide buildings, chimney height must still be determined as if $H = W$ (Figure 26).

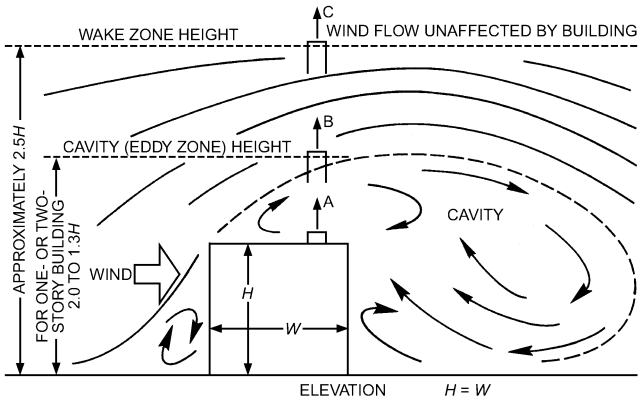
Chien et al. (1951) and Evans (1957) studied pitched roofs in relation to wind flow and surface pressures. Because the typical residence has a pitched roof and probably uses natural gas or a low-sulfur fossil fuel, dispersion is not important because combustion products are relatively free of pollutants. For example, NFPA *Standard* 54/AGA Z223.1 requires a minimum distance between the gas vent termination and any air intake, but it does not require penetration above the cavity zone.

Flow of wind over a chimney termination can impede or assist draft. In regions of stagnation on the windward side of a wall or a steep roof, winds create positive static pressures that impede established flow or cause backdrafts in vents and chimneys. Locating a chimney termination near the surface of a low, flat roof can aid draft because the entire roof surface is under negative static pressure. Velocity is low, however, because of the cavity formed as wind sweeps up over the building. With greater chimney height, termination above the low-velocity cavity or negative-pressure zone subjects the chimney exit to greater wind velocity, thereby increasing draft from two causes: (1) height and (2) wind aspiration over an open top. As the termination is moved from the center of the building to the sides, its exposure to winds and pressure also varies.

Terminations on pitched roofs may be exposed to either negative or positive static pressure, as well as to variation in wind velocity and direction. On the windward side, pitched roofs vary from complete to partial negative pressure as pitch increases from approximately flat to 30° (Chien et al. 1951). At a 45° pitch, the windward pitched roof surface is strongly positive; beyond this slope, pressures approach those observed on a vertical wall facing the wind. Wind pressure varies with its horizontal direction on a pitched roof, and on the lee (sheltered) side, wind velocity is very low, and static pressures are usually negative. Wind velocities and pressures vary not only with pitch, but with position between ridge and eaves. Reduction of these observed external wind effects to simple rules of termination for a wide variety of chimney and venting systems requires many compromises.

In the wake zone or any higher location exposed to full wind velocity, an open top can create strong venting updrafts. The updraft effect relative to wind dynamic pressure is related to the Reynolds number. Open tops, however, are sensitive to the wind angle as well as to rain (Clarke 1967), and many proprietary tops have been designed to stabilize wind effects and improve the performance. Because of the many compromises made in vent termination design, this stability is usually achieved by sacrificing some of the updraft created by the wind. Further, locating a vent cap in a cavity region frequently removes it from the zone where wind velocity could have a significant effect.

Performance optimization studies of residential vent cap design indicate that the following performance features are important: (1) still-air resistance, (2) updraft ability with no flow, and (3) discharge resistance when vent gases are carried at low velocity in a



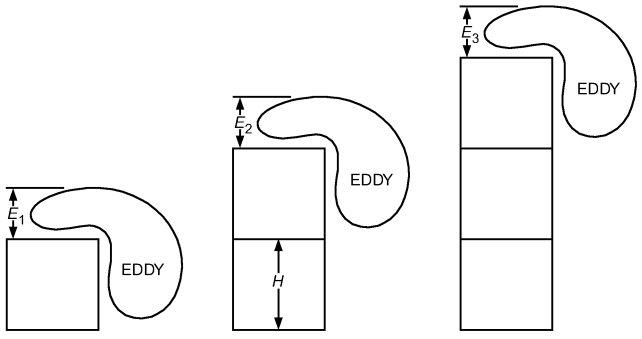
Chimney heights:

A: Discharge into cavity should be avoided because reentry will occur. Dispersion equations do not apply.

B: Discharge above cavity is good. Reentry is avoided, but dispersion may be marginal or poor from standpoint of air pollution. Dispersion equations do not apply.

C: Discharge above wake zone is best; no reentry; maximum dispersion.

Fig. 26 Wind Eddy and Wake Zones for One- or Two-Story Buildings and Their Effect on Chimney Gas Discharge



E = EDDY HEIGHT ABOVE ROOF = $0.5H$

$E_1 = E_2 = E_3$

Studies found for a single cube-shaped building (length equals height) that (1) the height of the eddy above grade is 1.5 times the building height and (2) the height of unaffected air is 2.5 times height above grade. The eddy height above the roof equals $0.5H$, and does not change as building height increases in relation to building width.

Fig. 27 Height of Eddy Currents Around Single High-Rise Buildings

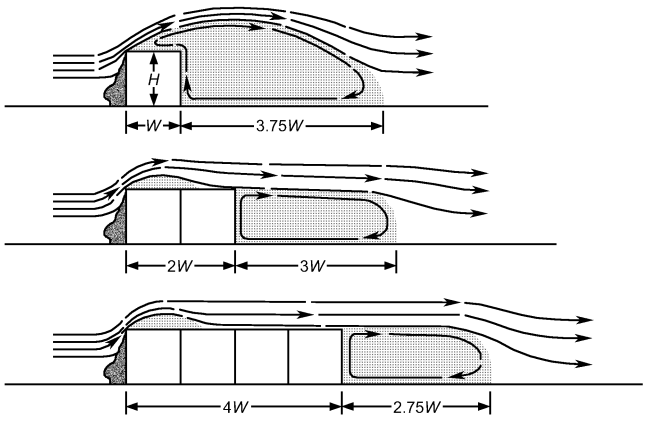


Fig. 28 Eddy and Wake Zones for Low, Wide Buildings

typical wind (3 m/s vent velocity in a 9 m/s wind). Tests in UL *Standard* 441 for proprietary gas vent caps consider these three aspects of performance to ensure adequate vent capacity.

Frequently, air supply to an appliance room is difficult to orient to eliminate wind effects. Therefore, the vent outlet must have a certain updraft capability, which can help balance a possible adverse wind. When wind flows across an inoperative vent termination, a strong updraft develops. Appliance start-up reduces this updraft, and in typical winds, the vent cap may develop greater resistance than it would have in still air. Certain vent caps can be made with very low still-air resistance, yet exhibit excessive wind resistance, which reduces capacity. Finally, because the appliance operates whether there is a wind or not, still-air resistance must be low.

Some proprietary air ventilators have excessive still-air resistance and should be avoided on vent and chimney systems unless a considerably oversized vent is specified. Vertical-slot ventilators, for example, have still-air resistance coefficients of about 4.5. To achieve low still-air resistance on vents and chimneys, the vertical-slot ventilator must be 50% larger than the diameter of the chimney or vent unless it has been specifically listed for such use.

Freestanding chimneys high enough to project above the cavity zone require structurally adequate materials or guying and bracing for prefabricated products. The prefabricated metal building heating appliance chimney places little load on the roof structure, but guying is required at 2.4 to 3.6 m intervals to resist both overturning and oscillating wind forces. Various other expedients, such as spiral baffles on heavy-gage freestanding chimneys, have been used to reduce oscillation.

The chimney height needed to carry the effluent into the undisturbed flow stream above the wake zone can be reduced by increasing the effluent discharge velocity. A 15 m/s discharge velocity avoids downward eddying along the chimney and expels the effluent free of the wake zone. Velocity this high can be achieved only with forced or induced draft.

Rain entry is a problem for open, low-velocity, or inoperative systems. Good results have been obtained with drains that divert the water onto a roof or into a collection system leading to a sump. Figure 29 shows several configurations (Clarke 1967; Hama and Downing 1963). Runoff from stack drains contains acids, soot, and metallic corrosion products, which can cause roof staining. Therefore, these methods are not recommended for residential use. An alternative procedure is to allow all water to drain to the base of the chimney, where it is piped from a capped tee to a sump.

Rain caps prevent vertical discharge of high-velocity flue gases. However, caps are preferred for residential gas-burning equipment because it is easier to exclude rain than to risk rainwater leakage at horizontal joints or to drain it. Also, caps keep out debris and bird nests, which can block the chimney. Satisfactory vent cap performance can be achieved in the wind by using one of a variety of standard configurations, including the A cap and the wind band ventilator, or one of the proprietary designs shown in Figure 29. Where partial rain protection without excessive flow resistance is desired, and either wind characteristics are unimportant or windflow is horizontal, a flat disk or cone cap 1.7 to 2.0 diameters across located 0.5 diameter above the end of the pipe has a still-air resistance loss coefficient of about 0.5.

See Chapter 46 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for additional information on vent and chimney termination and wind effects.

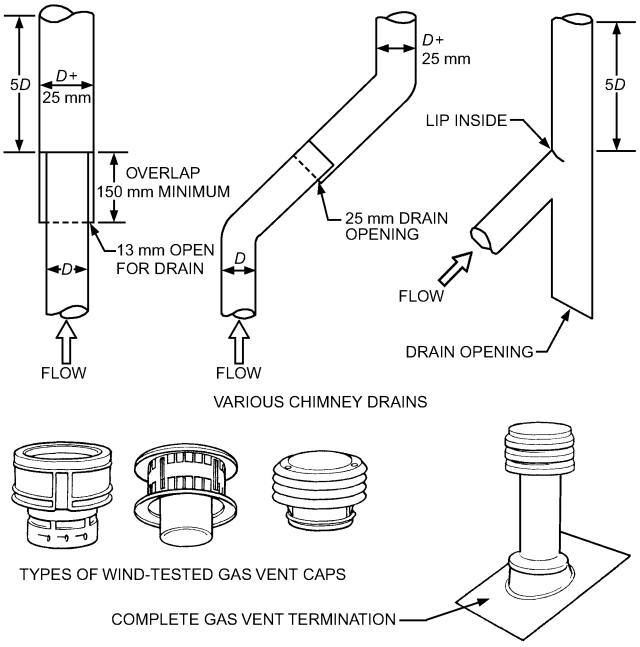


Fig. 29 Vent and Chimney Rain Protection

Table 11 List of U.S. National Standards Relating to Installation[a]

Subject	Materials Covered	NFPA[b]	ANSI[c]	CSA[f]
Oil-burning equipment	Type L listed chimneys, single-wall, masonry	31	—	—
Gas appliances and gas piping	Type B, L listed chimneys, single-wall, masonry	54	Z223.1[d]	B149.1
Chimneys, fireplaces, vents, and solid-fuel-burning appliances	All types	211	—	CAN/ULC S605-M91
Recreational vehicles	Roof jacks and vents	1192	—	—
Gas piping and gas equipment on industrial premises	All types	54	Z223.1[d]	B149.1
Gas conversion burners	Chimneys		Z21.8[e]	—
	Safe design		Z21.17[e]	—
Draft hoods	Part dimensions		Z21.12[e]	CAN1-6.2
Automatic vent dampers for use with gas-fired appliances	Construction and performance		Z21.66[e]	—

[a]These standards are subject to periodic review and revision to reflect advances in industry, as well as for consistency with legal requirements and other codes.
[b]National Fire Protection Association, Quincy, MA.
[c]American National Standards Institute, New York.
[d]Available from American Gas Association, Washington, D.C.
[e]Available from CSA America, Cleveland, OH.
[f]Canadian Standards Association, Mississauga, ON.

15. CODES AND STANDARDS

Building and installation codes and standards prescribe the installation and safety requirements of heat-producing appliances and their vents and chimneys. Chapter 52 lists the major national building codes, one of which may be in effect in a given area. Some jurisdictions either adopt a national building code with varying degrees of revisions to suit local custom or, as in many major metropolitan areas, develop a local code that agrees in principle but shares little common text with the national codes. Familiarity with applicable building codes is essential because of the great variation in local codes and adoption of modern chimney design practice.

The national standards listed in Table 11 give greater detail on the mechanical aspects of fuel systems and chimney or vent construction. Although these standards emphasize safety aspects, especially clearances to combustibles for various venting materials, they also recognize the importance of proper flow, draft, and capacity.

16. SYMBOLS

A = area of passage cross section, m^2
A_c = chimney flue cross-sectional area, m^2
A_F = fireplace frontal opening area, m^2
B = existing or local barometric pressure, Pa
B_o = standard pressure, Pa (101 325 Pa)
C_u = temperature multiplier for heat loss, dimensionless
c_p = specific heat of gas at constant pressure, kJ/(kg·K)
d_f = inside diameter, m
d_i = inside diameter, mm
D_a = available draft, Pa
D_b = boost (increase in static pressure by fan), Pa
D_p = depressurization, Pa
D_t = theoretical draft, Pa
F = friction factor for L/d_i
f = Darcy friction factor from Moody diagram (Figure 13, Chapter 3, 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*)
H = height of vent or chimney system above grade or system inlet, m
I = operating heat input, MJ/s (MW)
k = system resistance loss coefficient, dimensionless
k_f = fitting friction loss coefficient, dimensionless
k_L = piping friction loss coefficient, dimensionless
L = length of all piping in chimney system from inlet to exit, linear metres
L_m = length of system from inlet to midpoint of vertical or to location of mean gas temperature, m
M = mass flow to input ratio, kg/MJ
Q = volumetric flow rate, m^3/s
q = sensible heat at particular point in vent, MJ/s
q_m = sensible heat at average temperature in vent, MJ/s
T = absolute temperature, K
T_m = mean flue gas temperature at average conditions in system, K
T_o = ambient temperature, K
T_s = standard temperature, K (288.15 K)
U = overall heat transfer coefficient of vent or chimney wall material, referred to inside surface area, $W/(m^2 \cdot K)$
$\overline{U}$ = heat transfer coefficient for Equation (6), $W/(m^2 \cdot K)$
V = velocity of gas flow in passage, m/s
V_F = frontal velocity of ambient air, m/s
w = mass flow of gas, g/s
x = length of one internal side of rectangular chimney cross section, m
y = length of other internal side of rectangular chimney cross section, m
Δp = system flow losses or pressure drop, Pa
Δt = temperature difference, K
Δt_e = temperature difference entering system, K
Δt_m = temperature difference at average temperature location in system, K ($\Delta t_m = T_m - T_o$)
ρ_o = density of air at 288.15 K and 101 325 Pa, kg/m^3 (1.226 kg/m^3)
ρ_m = density of chimney gas at average temperature and local barometric pressure, kg/m^3

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CHAPTER 36

HYDRONIC HEAT-DISTRIBUTING UNITS AND RADIATORS

Description 36.1
Ratings of Heat-Distributing Units 36.2
Design 36.3
Applications 36.5

RADIATORS, convectors, and baseboard and finned-tube units are heat-distributing devices used in hot-water and steam heating systems. They supply heat by a **combination of radiation and convection** and maintain the desired air temperature and/or mean radiant temperature in a space without fans. Figures 1 and 2 show sections of typical heat-distributing units. In heating systems, radiant panels are also used. Units are inherently self-adjusting in the sense that heat output is based on temperature differentials; cold spaces receive more heat and warmer spaces receive less heat.

1. DESCRIPTION

Radiators

The term *radiator*, though generally confined to sectional cast-iron column, large-tube, or small-tube units, also includes flat-panel types and fabricated steel sectional types. Small-tube radiators, with a length of only 45 mm per section, occupy less space than column and large-tube units and are particularly suited to installation in recesses (see Table 1). Column, wall-type, and large-tube radiators are no longer manufactured, although many of these units are still in use. See Tables 2, 3, and 4 in Chapter 28 of the 1988 *ASHRAE Handbook—Equipment*, Byrley (1978), or Hydronics Institute (1989) for principal dimensions and average ratings of these units.

The following are the most common types of radiators:

Sectional radiators are fabricated from welded sheet metal sections (generally two, three, or four tubes wide), and resemble free-standing cast-iron radiators.

Panel radiators consist of fabricated flat panels (generally one, two, or three deep), with or without an exposed extended fin surface attached to the rear for increased output. These radiators are most common in Europe.

Tubular steel radiators consist of supply and return headers with interconnecting parallel steel tubes in a wide variety of lengths and heights. They may be specially shaped to coincide with the building structure. Some are used to heat bathroom towel racks.

Specialty radiators are fabricated of welded steel or extruded aluminum and are designed for installation in ceiling grids or floor-mounting. Various unconventional shapes are available.

Pipe Coils

Pipe coils have largely been replaced by finned tubes. See Table 5 in Chapter 28 of the 1988 *ASHRAE Handbook—Equipment* for the heat emission of such pipe coils.

Convectors

A convector is a heat-distributing unit that operates with gravity-circulated air (natural convection). It has a heating element with a large amount of secondary surface and contains two or more tubes with headers at both ends. The heating element is surrounded by an enclosure with an air inlet below and an air outlet above the heating element.

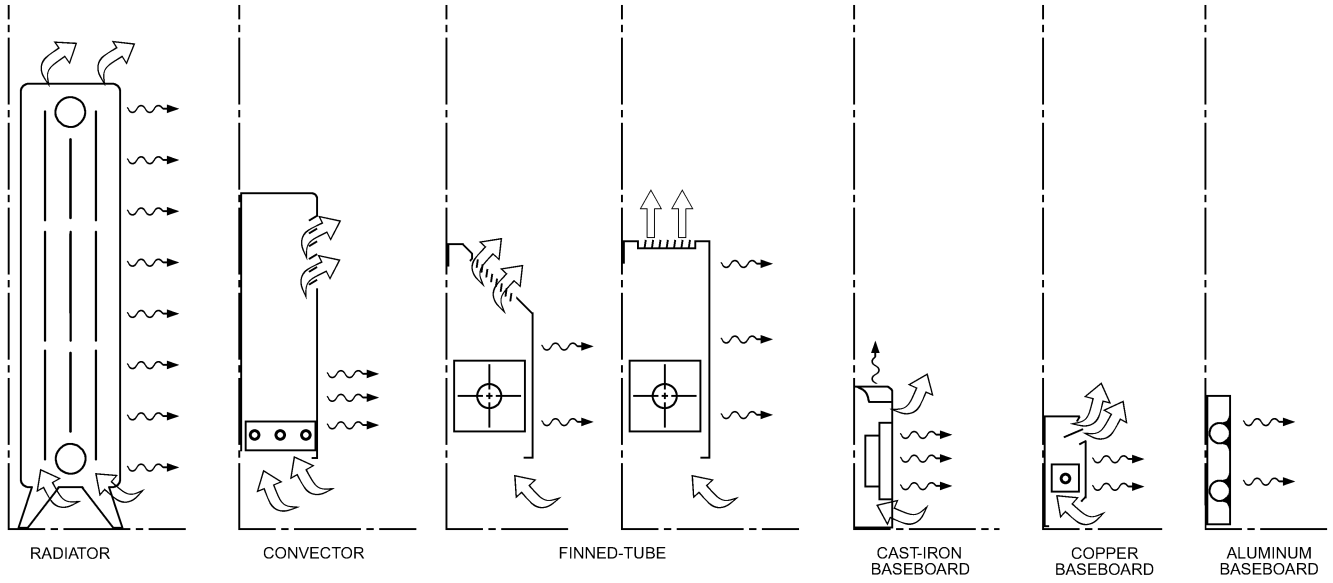


Fig. 1 Terminal Units

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.1, Hydronic and Steam Equipment and Systems.

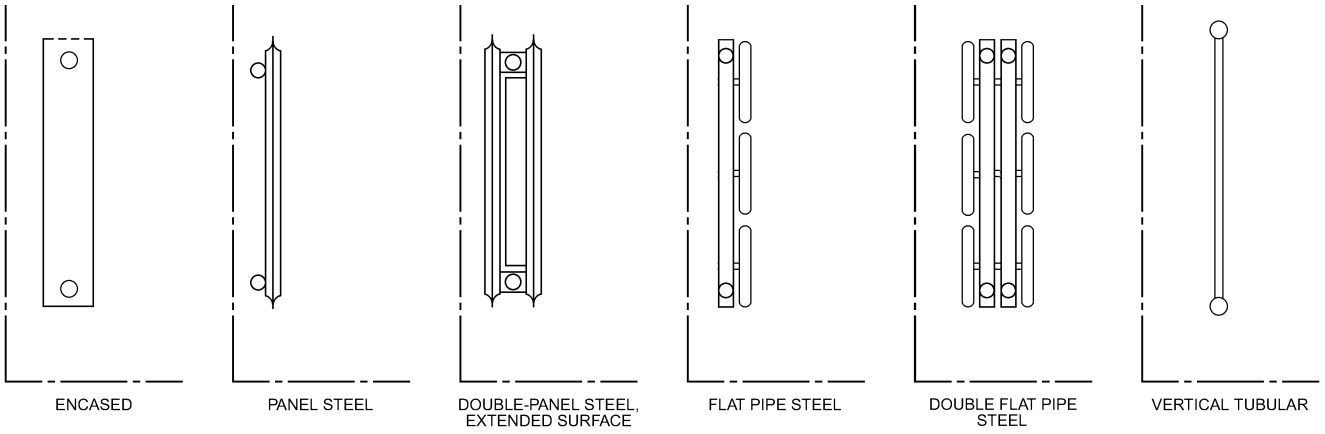


Fig. 2 Typical Radiators

Convectors are made in a variety of depths, sizes, and lengths and in enclosure or cabinet types. The heating elements are available in fabricated ferrous and nonferrous metals. Air enters the enclosure below the heating element, is heated in passing through the element, and leaves the enclosure through the outlet grille located above the heating element. Factory-assembled units comprising a heating element and an enclosure are common, and may be freestanding, wall-hung, or recessed and may have outlet grilles or louvers and arched inlets or inlet grilles or louvers, as desired.

Baseboard Units

Baseboard (or baseboard radiation) units are designed for installation along the bottom of walls in place of conventional baseboard. They may be made of cast iron, with a substantial portion of the front face directly exposed to the room, or with a finned-tube element in a sheet metal enclosure. They use gravity-circulated room air.

Baseboard heat-distributing units are divided into three types: radiant, radiant convector, and finned tube. The **radiant** unit, which is made of aluminum, has no openings for air to pass over the wall side of the unit. Most of this unit's heat output is by radiation.

The **radiant-convector** baseboard is made of cast iron or steel. The units have air openings at the top and bottom to allow circulation of room air over the wall side of the unit, which has extended surface to provide increased heat output. A large portion of the heat emitted is transferred by convection.

The **finned-tube** baseboard has a finned-tube heating element concealed by a long, low sheet metal enclosure or cover. A major portion of the heat is transferred to the room by convection. The output varies over a wide range, depending on the physical dimensions and the materials used. Avoid using a unit with a high relative output per unit length compared to overall heat loss, which would result in a concentration of the heating element over a relatively small area. Optimum comfort for room occupants is obtained when units are installed along as much of the exposed wall as possible.

Finned-Tube Units

Finned-tube (or fin-tube) units are fabricated from metallic tubing, with metallic fins bonded to the tube. They operate with gravity-circulated room air. Finned-tube elements are available in several tube sizes, in either steel or copper (25 to 50 mm nominal steel or 22 to 35 mm nominal copper) with various fin sizes, spacings, and materials. Resistance to steam or water flow is the same as that through standard distribution piping of equal size and type.

Finned-tube elements installed in occupied spaces generally have covers or enclosures in a variety of designs. When human contact is unlikely, they are sometimes installed bare or provided with an expanded metal grille for minimum protection.

A **cover** has a portion of the front skirt made of solid material. The cover can be mounted with clearance between the wall and the cover, and without completely enclosing the rear of the finned-tube element. A cover may have a top, front, or inclined outlet. An **enclosure** is a shield of solid material that completely encloses both the front and rear of the finned-tube element. The enclosure may have an integral back or may be installed tightly against the wall so that the wall forms the back, and it may have a top, front, or inclined outlet.

Heat Emission

These heat-distributing units emit heat by a combination of radiation to the surfaces and occupants in the space and convection to the air in the space.

Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* covers the heat transfer processes and the factors that influence them. Those units with a large portion of their heated surface exposed to the space (i.e., radiator and cast-iron baseboard) emit more heat by radiation than do units with completely or partially concealed heating surfaces (i.e., convector, finned-tube, and finned-tube baseboard). Also, finned-tube elements constructed of steel emit a larger portion of heat by radiation than do finned-tube elements constructed of nonferrous materials.

The heat output ratings of heat-distributing units are expressed in watts or in square metres equivalent direct radiation (EDR).

2. RATINGS OF HEAT-DISTRIBUTING UNITS

For convectors, baseboard units, and finned-tube units, an allowance for heating effect may be added to the **test capacity** (the heat extracted from the steam or water under standard test conditions). This **heating effect** reflects the ability of the unit to direct its heat output to the occupied zone of a room. The application of a heating effect factor implies that some units use less steam or hot water than others to produce an equal comfort effect in a room.

Radiators

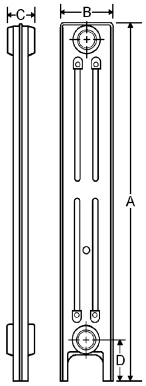
Current methods for rating radiators were established by the U.S. National Bureau of Standards publication, *Simplified Practices Recommendation* R174-65, Cast-Iron Radiators, which has been withdrawn (Table 1).

Convectors

The generally accepted method of testing and rating ferrous and nonferrous convectors in the United States was given in *Commercial Standard* CS 140-47, Testing and Rating Convectors (Dept. of

Table 1 Small-Tube Cast-Iron Radiators

Number of Tubes per Section	Catalog Rating per Section,[a] W	Section Dimensions				
		A Height, mm[b]	B Width, mm		C Spacing, mm[c]	D Leg Height, mm[b]
			Min.	Max.		
3	113	635	83	89	45	65
4	113	483	113	122	45	65
	127	559	113	122	45	65
	141	635	113	122	45	65
5	148	559	143	160	45	65
	169	635	143	160	45	65
6	162	483	173	203	45	65
	211	635	173	203	45	65
	260	813	173	203	45	65



[a] Ratings based on steam at 101.7°C and air at 21.1°C. They apply only to installed radiators exposed in a normal manner, not to radiators installed behind enclosures, behind grilles, or under shelves. For ratings at other temperatures, multiply table values by factors found in Table 2.

[b] Overall height and leg height, as produced by some manufacturers, are 25 mm greater than shown in columns A and D. Radiators may be furnished without legs. Where greater than standard leg heights are required, leg height should be 115 mm.

[c] Length equals number of sections multiplied by 45 mm.

Commerce 1947), but it has been withdrawn. This standard contained details covering construction and instrumentation of the test booth or room and procedures for determining steam and water ratings.

Under the provisions of *Commercial Standard* CS 140-47, the rating of a top outlet convector was established at a value not in excess of the test capacity. For convectors with other types of enclosures or cabinets, a percentage that varies up to a maximum of 15% (depending on the height and type of enclosure or cabinet) was added for heating effect (Brabbee 1926; Willard et al. 1929). The addition made for heating effect must be shown in the manufacturer's literature.

The testing and rating procedure set forth by *Commercial Standard* CS 140-47 does not apply to finned-tube or baseboard radiation.

Baseboard Units

The generally accepted method of testing and rating baseboards in the United States is covered in the *Testing and Rating Standard for Baseboard Radiation* (AHRI 2005). This standard contains details covering construction and instrumentation of the test booth or room, procedures for determining steam and hot-water ratings, and licensing provisions for obtaining approval of these ratings. Baseboard ratings include an allowance for heating effect of 15% in addition to the test capacity. The addition made for heating effect must be shown in the manufacturer's literature.

Finned-Tube Units

The generally accepted method of testing and rating finned-tube units in the United States is covered in AHRI *Standard* 1410. This standard contains details covering construction and instrumentation of the test booth or room, procedures for determining steam and water ratings, and licensing provisions for obtaining approval of these ratings.

The rating of a finned-tube unit in an enclosure that has a top outlet is no greater than the test capacity. For finned-tube units with other types of enclosures or covers, a percentage is added for heating effect that varies up to a maximum of 15%, depending on the height and type of enclosure or cover. The addition made for heating effect must be shown in the manufacturer's literature (Pierce 1963).

Other Heat-Distributing Units

Unique radiators and radiators from other countries generally are tested and rated for heat emission in accordance with prevailing standards. These other testing and rating methods have basically the same procedures as the Hydronics Institute and AHRI standards, which are used in the United States. See Chapter 6 for information on the design and sizing of radiant panels.

Corrections for Nonstandard Conditions

The heating capacity of a radiator, convector, baseboard, finned-tube heat-distributing unit, or radiant panel is a power function of the temperature difference between the air in the room and the heating medium in the unit, shown as

$$q = c(t_s - t_a)^n \quad (1)$$

where

q = heating capacity, W
c = constant determined by test
t_s = average temperature of heating medium, °C. For hot water, use arithmetic average of entering and leaving water temperatures.
t_a = room air temperature, °C. Air temperature 1.5 m above floor is generally used for radiators, whereas entering air temperature is used for convectors, baseboard units, and finned-tube units.
n = exponent that equals 1.2 for cast-iron radiators, 1.31 for baseboard radiation, 1.42 for convectors, 1.0 for ceiling heating and floor cooling panels, and 1.1 for floor heating and ceiling cooling panels. For finned-tube units, n varies with air and heating medium temperatures. Correction factors to convert heating capacities at standard rating conditions to heating capacities at other conditions are given in Table 2.

Equation (1) may also be used to calculate heating capacity at nonstandard conditions.

3. DESIGN

Effect of Water Velocity

Designing for high temperature drops through the system (as much as 35 to 45 K in low-temperature water (LTW) systems and as much as 110 K in high-temperature systems) can result in low water velocities in the finned-tube or baseboard element. Applying very short runs designed for conventional temperature drops (i.e., 10 K) can also result in low velocities.

Figure 3 shows the effect of water velocity on the heat output of typical sizes of finned-tube elements. The figure is based on work done by Harris (1957) and Pierce (1963) and tests at the Hydronics Institute. The velocity correction factor F_v is

Table 2 Correction Factors *c* for Various Types of Heating Units

Steam Pressure (Approx.), kPa (absolute)	Steam or Water Temp., °C	Radiator			Convector			Finned-Tube			Baseboard		
		Room Temp., °C			Air Temp., °C			Air Temp., °C			Air Temp., °C		
		25	20	15	25	20	15	25	20	15	25	20	15
9.5	45	—	—	—	—	—	—	0.15	0.21	0.26	0.14	0.19	0.24
15.8	55	—	—	0.40	—	—	0.33	0.26	0.32	0.37	0.24	0.30	0.36
25.0	65	0.40	0.47	0.54	0.33	0.40	0.47	0.37	0.44	0.50	0.36	0.43	0.49
38.6	75	0.54	0.61	0.68	0.47	0.54	0.61	0.50	0.57	0.64	0.49	0.56	0.63
57.9	85	0.68	0.76	0.83	0.61	0.69	0.77	0.64	0.71	0.78	0.63	0.70	0.78
84.6	95	0.83	0.91	0.99	0.77	0.85	0.93	0.78	0.86	0.94	0.78	0.86	0.94
120.9	105	0.99	1.07	1.15	0.93	1.02	1.11	0.94	1.01	1.09	0.94	1.02	1.11
169.2	115	1.15	1.24	1.32	1.11	1.20	1.30	1.09	1.18	1.26	1.11	1.20	1.29
232.3	125	1.32	1.41	1.50	1.30	1.40	1.50	1.26	1.34	1.42	1.29	1.38	1.47
313.4	135	1.50	1.59	1.68	1.50	1.60	1.70	1.42	1.51	1.60	1.47	1.57	1.66
415.8	145	1.68	1.77	1.86	1.70	1.81	1.92	1.60	1.69	1.78	1.66	1.76	1.86

Note: Use these correction factors to determine output ratings for radiators, convectors, and finned-tube and baseboard units at operating conditions other than standard. Standard conditions in the United States for a radiator are 102°C heating medium temperature and 21°C room temperature (at center of space and at 1.5 m level).

Standard conditions for convectors and finned-tube and baseboard units are 102°C heating medium temperature and 18°C inlet air temperature at 101.3 kPa atmospheric pressure. Water flow is 0.9 m/s for finned-tube units. Inlet air at 18°C for convectors and finned-tube or baseboard units represents the same room comfort conditions as 21°C room air temperature for a radiator. Standard conditions for radiant panels are 50°C heating medium temperature and 20°C for room air temperature; *c* depends on panel construction.

To determine output of a heating unit under nonstandard conditions, multiply standard heating capacity by appropriate factor for actual operating heating medium and room or inlet air temperatures.

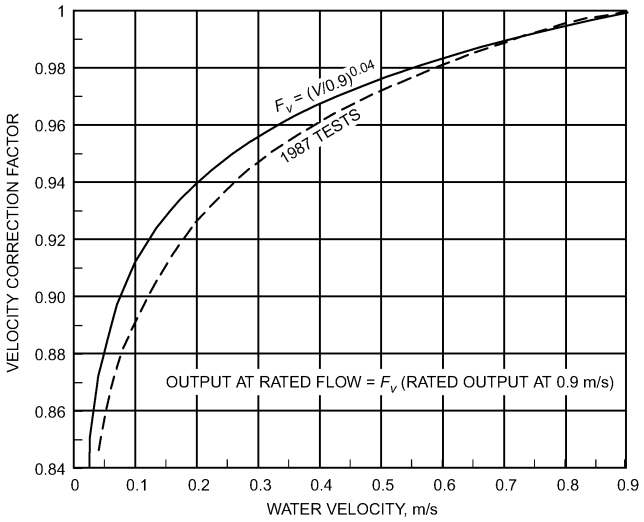


Fig. 3 Water Velocity Correction Factor for Baseboard and Finned-Tube Radiators

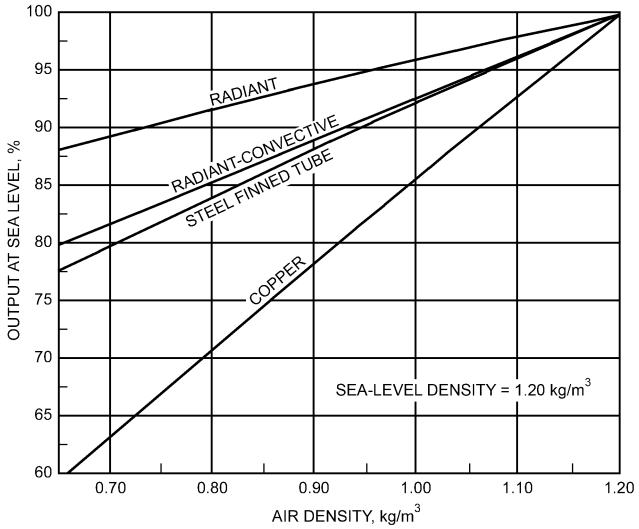


Fig. 4 Effect of Air Density on Radiator Output

$$F_v = (V/0.9)^{0.0} \quad (2)$$

where V = water velocity, m/s.

Heat output varies little over the range from 0.15 to 0.9 m/s, where F_v ranges from 0.93 to 1.00. The factor drops rapidly below 0.15 m/s because flow changes from turbulent to laminar at around 0.03 m/s. Avoid such a low velocity because the output is difficult to predict accurately when designing a system. In addition, the curve is so steep in this region that small changes in actual flow have a significant effect on output. Not only does the heat transfer rate change, but the temperature drop and, therefore, the average water temperature change (assuming a constant inlet temperature).

The designer should check water velocity throughout the system and select finned-tube or baseboard elements on the basis of velocity as well as average temperature. Manufacturers of finned-tube and baseboard elements offer a variety of tube sizes, ranging from 15 mm copper tubes for small baseboard elements to 50 mm for large finned-tube units, to aid in maintenance of turbulent flow conditions over a wide range of flow.

Effect of Altitude

The effect of altitude on heat output varies depending on the material used and the portion of the unit's output that is radiant rather than convective. The reduced air density affects the convective portion. Figure 4 shows the reduction in heat output with air density (Sward and Decker 1965). The approximate correction factor F_A for determining the reduced output of typical units is

$$F_A = (p/p_o)^n \quad (3)$$

where

p = local station atmospheric pressure
p_o = standard atmospheric pressure
n = 0.9 for copper baseboard or finned tube
= 0.5 for steel finned-tube or cast-iron baseboard

= 0.2 for radiant baseboard and radiant panels

The value of p/p_o at various altitudes may be calculated as follows:

$$p/p_o = e^{-1.22\times10^{-4}h} \quad (4)$$

where h = altitude, m. The following are typical values of p/p_o:

Altitude h, m	p/p_o
600	0.93
1200	0.86
1500	0.83
1800	0.80

Sward and Harris (1970) showed that some components of heat loss are affected in the same manner.

Effect of Mass

Mass of the terminal unit (typically cast-iron versus copper-aluminum finned element) affects the heat-up and cooldown rates of equipment. It is important that high- and low-mass radiation not be mixed in the same zone. High-mass systems have historically been favored for best comfort and economy, but tests by Harris (1970) showed no measurable difference. The thermostat or control can compensate by changing the burner's cycle rate. The effect of mass is further reduced by constantly circulating modulated temperature water to the unit. The only time that mass can have a significant effect is in response to a giant shift in load. In that situation, the low-mass unit will respond faster.

Performance at Low Water Temperatures

Table 2 summarizes the performance of baseboard and finned-tube units with an average water temperature down to 38°C. Solar-heated water, industrial waste heat in a low- to medium-temperature district heating system, condensing boilers, heat pump system cooling water, and ground-source heat pumps are typical applications in this range. To compensate for heating capacity loss, either heat-distributing equipment should be oversized, or additional heat-distributing units should be installed. Minimize capital and operating costs (Kilkis 1998).

Effect of Enclosure and Paint

An enclosure placed around a direct radiator restricts airflow and diminishes the proportion of output resulting from radiation. However, enclosures of proper design may improve heat distribution in the room compared to that obtained with an unenclosed radiator (Allcut 1933; Willard et al. 1929).

For a radiator or cast-iron baseboard, the finish coat of paint affects the heat output. Oil paints of any color give about the same results as unpainted black or rusty surfaces, but an aluminum or a bronze paint reduces the heat emitted by radiation. The net effect may reduce the total heat output of the radiator by 10% or more (Allen 1920; Rubert 1937; Severns 1927).

4. APPLICATIONS

Radiators

Radiators can be used with steam or hot water. They are installed in areas of greatest heat loss: under windows, along cold walls, or at doorways. They can be freestanding, semirecessed, or with decorative enclosures or shields (although these affect output) (Willard et al. 1929).

Unique and imported radiators are generally not suitable for steam applications, although they have been used extensively in low-temperature water systems with valves and connecting piping left exposed. Various combinations of supply and return locations are possible, and may alter heat output. Although long lengths may be ordered for linear applications, lengths may not be reduced or increased by field modification. The small cross-sectional areas often inherent in unique radiators require careful evaluation of flow requirements, water temperature drop, and pressure drops.

Convectors

Convectors can be used with steam or hot water. Like radiators, they should be installed in areas of greatest heat loss. They are particularly applicable where wall space is limited, such as in entryways and kitchens.

Baseboard Radiation

Baseboard units are used almost exclusively with hot water. When used with one-pipe steam systems, tube sizes of 32 mm nominal diameter must be used to allow drainage of condensate counterflow to the steam flow.

The basic advantage of the baseboard unit is that its normal placement is along the cold walls and under areas where the greatest heat loss occurs. Other advantages are that it (1) is inconspicuous, (2) offers minimal interference with furniture placement, and (3) distributes the heat near the floor. This last characteristic reduces the floor-to-ceiling temperature gradient to about 1 to 2 K and tends to produce uniform temperature throughout the room. It also makes baseboard heat-distributing units adaptable to homes without basements, where cold floors are common (Kratz and Harris 1945).

Heat loss calculations for baseboard heating are the same as those used for other types of heat-distributing units. Hydronics Institute (1989) describes a procedure for designing baseboard heating systems.

Finned-Tube Radiation

The finned-tube unit can be used with either steam or hot water. It is advantageous for heat distribution along the entire outside wall, thereby preventing downdrafts along the walls in buildings such as schools, churches, hospitals, offices, airports, and factories. It may be the principal source of heat in a building or a supplementary heater to combat downdrafts along the exposed walls in conjunction with a central conditioned air system. Its placement under or next to windows or glass panels helps to prevent fogging or condensation on the glass.

Normal placement of a finned tube is along the walls where the heat loss is greatest. If necessary, the units can be installed in two or three tiers along the wall. Hot-water installations requiring two or three tiers may run a serpentine water flow if the energy loss is not excessive. A header connection with parallel flow may be used, but the design must not (1) allow water to short circuit along the path of least resistance, (2) reduce capacity because of low water velocity in each tier, or (3) cause one or more tiers to become air-bound.

Many enclosures have been developed to meet building design requirements. The wide variety of finned-tube elements (tube size and material, fin size, spacing, fin material, and multiple-tier installation), along with the various heights and designs of enclosures, give great flexibility of selection for finned-tube units that meet the needs of load, space, and appearance.

In areas where zone control rather than individual room control can be applied, all finned-tube units in the zone should be in series. In such a series loop installation, however, temperature drop must be considered in selecting the element for each separate room in the loop.

Radiant Panels

Hydronic radiant heating panels are controlled-temperature surfaces on the floor, walls, or ceiling; a heated fluid circulates through a circuit embedded in or attached to the panel. More than 50% of the total heating capacity is transmitted by radiant heat transfer. Usually, 50°C mean fluid temperature delivers enough heat to indoor

surfaces. With such low temperature ratings, hydronic radiant panels are suitable for low-temperature heating. See Chapter 6 for more information.

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CHAPTER 37

SOLAR ENERGY EQUIPMENT AND SYSTEMS

SOLAR HEATING SYSTEMS 37.2
Air-Heating Systems 37.2
Liquid-Heating Systems 37.2
Solar Thermal Energy Collectors 37.3
Row Design 37.6
Array Design 37.7
Thermal Collector Performance 37.9
Thermal Energy Storage 37.11
Heat Exchangers 37.16
Controls 37.17
PHOTOVOLTAIC SYSTEMS 37.19

SOLAR energy use is becoming more economical, primarily due to technological maturity, economies of scale, and governmental policies with immediate interest in low-carbon and sustainable construction (Kavlak et al. 2018). In addition, many countries consider solar and renewable energy a security measure, to ensure the availability of power under adverse conditions. While the United States continues to grow its solar industry, China, Europe, Asia, and the Mediterranean basin are leading development of advanced manufacturing techniques and applications. However, equipment and systems are still very similar in all markets; therefore, this chapter primarily discusses the basic equipment used, with particular attention to collectors. More detailed descriptions of systems and designs can be found in Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications.*

Commercial and industrial solar thermal energy systems are generally classified according to the heat transfer medium used in the collector loop (i.e., air or liquid). Although both systems share basic fundamentals of conversion for solar radiant energy, the equipment used in each is entirely different. Air systems are primarily limited to forced-air space heating and industrial and agricultural drying processes. Liquid systems are suitable for a broader range of applications, such as hydronic space heating, service water heating, industrial process water heating, energizing heat-driven air conditioning, and pool heating, and as a heat source for series-coupled heat pumps. Because of this wide range in capability, liquid systems are more common than air systems in commercial and industrial applications.

As shown in Table 1, global installed thermal capacity of solar collectors at the end of 2017 reached 473.8 gigawatts (GW_{th}), which corresponds to an annual solar thermal energy yield of at least 390 TWh (Weiss and Spork-Dur 2018). Unglazed water collectors are used mainly for low-temperature (e.g., swimming pool) heating; their main markets are in North America (i.e., the United States and Canada) with an installed capacity of 16.1 GW_{th}, followed by Australia and Brazil (3.7 GW_{th} each). Glazed flat-plate and evacuated-tube collectors, which are mainly used to generate domestic hot water and space heating, dominate the market in China (334.5 GW_{th}), Turkey (16.3 GW_{th}), and Germany (13.3 GW_{th}).

By the end of 2017, the total thermal capacity in operation in the European Union exceeded 36.5 GW_{th}, corresponding to 52.1 million m^2 of collector area. Germany is the leader in terms of market volume, with about 38% of the European market, whereas Austria, Greece, Italy, Spain, France, and Poland together account for about 45%. Solar hot-water systems are now mandatory in new buildings according to solar ordinances in Cyprus, Greece, Italy, Portugal, Slovenia, Spain, and elsewhere in Europe.

China is the leader in the global solar heating industry, producing an estimated 334.5 GW_{th} or 477.8 million m^2 of collectors in 2017. Most installations in China use evacuated-tube collectors for domestic hot water only. The trend in Europe is towards larger **solar-combi systems** that provide both domestic hot water and space heating, accounting for half of the annual market in Austria and Germany (Balaras et al. 2010), as well as multipurpose heat-pump-assisted solar systems (Todorovic et al. 2010). The U.S. market for solar hot-water collectors (excluding unglazed swimming pool heating) is still relatively small but is gaining ground (especially in California): some states have set solar thermal carve-outs in their renewable portfolio standards (RPS), or allow electric utilities to meet RPS requirements with solar water heating systems (REN21 2018). Other markets that are growing quickly include Denmark, India, Mexico, Australia, and South Africa, although some of these markets are challenged by a lack of standards, leading to use of inferior products and poor installations, which have undermined the systems' reputation.

Table 1 Worldwide Solar Capacity in Operation by Type

	Capacity, GW_{th}	Equiv. Glazed Collector Area, 1 000 000 m^2
Glazed flat-plate collectors	107.2	153.1
Evacuated-tube collectors	336.6	480.9
Unglazed collectors	28.6	41.0
Glazed and unglazed air collectors	1.4	1.8
Total	**473.8**	**676.8**

Photovoltaic (PV) systems convert light from the sun directly into electricity for a wide variety of applications. The cost of PV systems has dropped significantly worldwide. At the end of 2017, the average price in the United States for installed systems varied from $2.88/W for grid-connected commercial systems to $0.98/W for grid-connected, ground-mounted ones (IEA 2018). This cost reduction has made PV systems considerably more economical, particularly when combined with federal tax credits and local incentives, and the amount of installed capacity has thus increased dramatically.

In 2018, the global cumulative installed photovoltaic capacity crossed the 500 GW_p mark and produced at least 660 TWh annually (IEA 2019a). China is the leader in terms of cumulative installed capacity (176.1GW_p), followed by the European Union (115 GW_p), United States (62.2 GW_p), and Japan (56 GW_p). Germany is also a leader, with about 39% of the cumulative European installed capacity, whereas Italy, the United Kingdom, France, Spain, Belgium, the Netherlands, and Austria together account for about 50%. Other markets that are also growing quickly include India, Australia, Mexico, Korea, and Turkey.

PV systems with thermal heat recovery (PVT) are a hybrid solar technology that integrates photovoltaic and thermal solar energy conversion within a single system. In PVT systems, the fraction of incident solar radiation that is absorbed is converted partially into electricity and partially into thermal energy that is recovered by a heat recovery fluid (air, water, or a refrigerant), reaching combined (electrical and thermal) efficiencies of up to 70%. By the end of

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.7, Solar Energy Utilization.

2018, a total of 524.2 MW_{th} thermal capacity of PVT modules and 178.2 MW_p of PV power was installed globally, corresponding to 1 million m² of PVT modules. Early adopters of this hybrid solar technology are France (215.6 MW_{th} and 70.1 MW_p), Korea (137.6 MW_{th} and 47.8 MW_p), China (65.6 MW_{th} and 22.8 MW_p), and Germany (53.6 MW_{th} and 18.6 MW_p). More information on PVT systems and designs can be found in Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

1. SOLAR HEATING SYSTEMS

Solar energy system design requires careful attention to detail because solar radiation is a low-intensity form of energy, and the equipment to collect and use it can be expensive. A brief overview of air and liquid systems is presented here to show how the equipment fits into each type of system. Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* covers solar energy use, and books on design, installation, operation, and maintenance are also available (ASHRAE 1988, 1990, 1991).

Solar energy and HVAC systems often use the same components and equipment. This chapter covers only the following elements, which are either exclusive to or have specific uses in solar energy applications:

- Collectors and collector arrays
- Thermal energy storage
- Heat exchangers
- Controls

Thermal energy storage is covered in Chapter 50, heat exchangers in Chapter 47, pumps in Chapter 44, and fans in Chapter 21.

1.1 AIR-HEATING SYSTEMS

Air-heating systems circulate air through ducts to and from an air heating collector (Figure 1). Air systems are effective for space heating because a heat exchanger is not required, and the collector inlet temperature is low throughout the day (approximately room temperature). Air systems do not need protection from freezing, overheat, or corrosion. Furthermore, air costs nothing and does not cause disposal problems or structural damage. However, air ducts and air-handling equipment require more space than pipes and pumps, ductwork is hard to seal, and leaks are difficult to detect. Fans consume more power than the pumps of a liquid system, but if the unit is installed in a facility that uses air distribution, only a slight power cost is chargeable against the solar space-heating system. Thermal storage for hot-air systems has been problematic as well because of the difficulty in controlling humidity and mold growth in pebble beds and other such devices, particularly in humid climates.

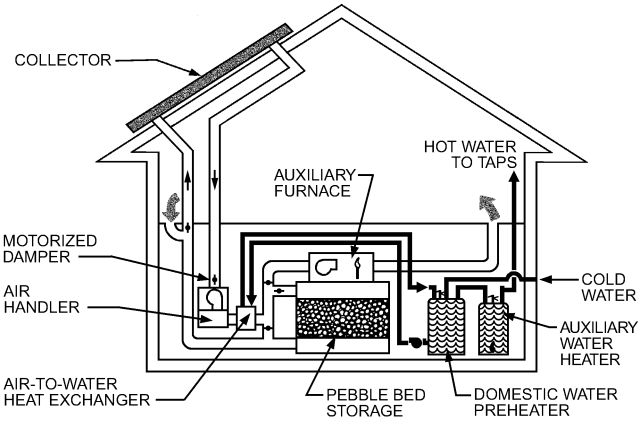


Fig. 1 Air-Heating Space and Domestic Water Heater System

Most air space-heating systems also preheat domestic hot water through an air-to-liquid heat exchanger. In this case, tightly fitting dampers are required to prevent reverse thermosiphoning at night, which could freeze water in the heat exchanger coil. If this system heats only water in the summer, the parasitic power consumption must be charged against the solar energy system because no space heating is involved and there are no comparable energy costs associated with conventional water heating. In some situations, solar water-heating systems could be more expensive than conventional water heaters, particularly if electrical energy costs are high. To reduce parasitic power consumption, some systems use the low speed of a two-speed fan.

1.2 LIQUID-HEATING SYSTEMS

Liquid-heating systems circulate a liquid, often a water-based fluid, through a solar collector (Figures 2 and 3). The liquid in solar collectors must be protected against freezing, which could damage the system.

Freezing is the principal cause of liquid system failure. For this reason, freeze tolerance is an important factor in selecting the heat transfer fluid and equipment in the collector loop. A solar collector radiates heat to the cold sky and freezes at air temperatures well above 0 °C. Where freezing conditions are rare, small solar heating systems are often equipped with low-cost protection devices that depend on simple manual, electrical, and/or mechanical components (e.g., electronic controllers and automatic valves) for freeze protection. Because of the large investment associated with most commercial and industrial installations, solar designers and installers must consider designs providing reliable freeze protection, even in the warmest climates.

Thermosiphon solar domestic hot-water heating systems operate at low, self-regulated collector flow rates. Their performance is generally better in temperate climates than active (using a pump to circulate the fluid) systems operating at conventional flow rates and is comparable to pump systems operating at low collector flow rates. Thermosiphon systems dominate the market in residential

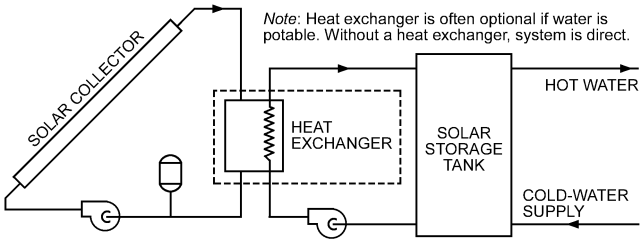


Fig. 2 Simplified Schematic of Indirect Nonfreezing System

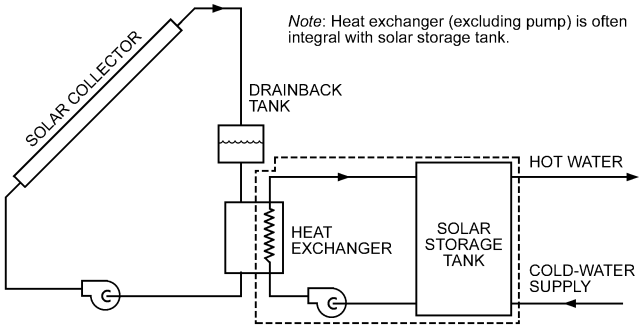


Fig. 3 Simplified Schematic of Indirect Drainback Freeze Protection System

and low-rise building applications in southern Europe and China, and Australia. The collector fluid is circulated by natural convection, eliminating the need for the pump and controller of an active system. The hot-water storage tank is placed above the collector area. The flow rate varies depending on the absorbed solar radiation, fluid temperatures, system geometry, etc.

Direct and Indirect Systems

In a direct liquid system, city water circulates through the collector. In an indirect system, the collector loop is separated from the high-pressure city water supply by a heat exchanger. In areas of poor water quality, isolation protects the collectors from fouling by minerals in the water. Indirect systems also offer greater freeze protection, so they are used almost exclusively in commercial and industrial applications.

Freeze Protection

Direct systems, used where freezing is infrequent and not severe, can avoid freeze damage by (1) recirculating warm storage water through the collectors, (2) continually flushing the collectors with cold water, or (3) isolating collectors from the water and draining them. Systems that can be drained to avoid freeze damage are called **drain-down** systems. Although all of these methods can be effective, none of them are generally approved by sanctioning bodies or recommended by manufacturers. Use caution when designing direct systems in freezing climates with any of these freeze protection schemes.

Indirect systems use two methods of freeze protection: (1) nonfreezing fluids and (2) drainback.

Nonfreezing Fluid Freeze Protection. The most popular solar energy system for commercial use is the indirect system with a nonfreezing heat transfer fluid to transmit heat from the solar collectors to storage (Figure 2). The most common heat transfer fluid is water/propylene glycol, although other heat transfer fluids such as silicone oils, hydrocarbon oils, or refrigerants can be used. Because the collector loop is closed and sealed, the only contribution to pump pressure is friction loss; therefore, the location of solar collectors relative to the heat exchanger and storage tank is not critical. Traditional hydronic sizing methods can be used for selecting pumps, expansion tanks, heat exchangers, and air removal devices, as long as the heat transfer liquid's thermal properties are considered.

When the control system senses an increase in solar panel temperature, the pump circulates the heat transfer liquid, and energy is collected. The same control also activates a pump on the domestic water side that circulates water through the heat exchanger, where it is heated by the heat transfer fluid. This mode continues until the temperature differential between the collector and the tank is too slight for meaningful energy to be collected. At this point, the control system shuts the pumps off. At low temperatures, the nonfreezing fluid protects the solar collectors and related piping from bursting. Because the heat transfer fluid can affect system performance, reliability, and maintenance requirements, fluid selection should be carefully considered.

Because the collector loop of the nonfreezing system remains filled with fluid, it allows flexibility in routing pipes and locating components. However, a double-separation (double-wall) heat exchanger is generally required (by local building codes) to prevent contamination of domestic water in the event of a leak. The double-wall heat exchanger also protects the collectors from freeze damage if water leaks into the collector loop. However, the double-wall heat exchanger reduces efficiency by forcing the collector to operate at a higher temperature. The heat exchanger can be placed inside the tank, or an external heat exchanger can be used, as shown in Figure 2. The collector loop is closed and, therefore, requires an expansion tank and pressure-relief valve. Air purge is also necessary to expel air during filling and to remove air that has been absorbed into the heat transfer fluid.

Overtemperature protection is necessary to ensure that the system operates within safe limits and to prevent collector fluid from corroding the absorber or heat exchanger. For maximum reliability, glycol should be replaced every few years.

In some cases, systems have failed because the collector fluid in the loop thermosiphoned and froze the water in the heat exchanger. If the water side is exposed to the city water system, this disastrous situation must be avoided by design.

Drainback Freeze Protection. A drainback solar water-heating system (see Figure 3) uses ordinary water as the heat transport medium between the collectors and thermal energy storage. Reverse-draining (or back-siphoning) the water into a drainback tank located in a nonfreezing environment protects the system from freezing whenever the controls turn off the circulator pump or a power outage occurs.

For drainback systems with a large amount of working fluid in the collector loop, heat loss can be significantly decreased and overall efficiency increased by including a tank for storing the heat transfer fluid at night. Using a night storage tank in large systems is an appropriate strategy even for regions with favorable meteorological conditions.

The drainback tank can be a sump with a volume slightly greater than the collector loop, or it can be the thermal energy storage tank. The collector loop may or may not be vented to the atmosphere. Many designers prefer the nonvented drainback loop because makeup water is not required and the corrosive effects of air that would otherwise be ingested into the collector loop are eliminated.

The drainback system is virtually fail-safe because it automatically reverts to a safe condition whenever the circulator pump stops. Furthermore, a 20 to 30% glycol solution can be added to drainback loops for added freeze protection in case of controller or sensor failure. Because the glycol is not exposed to stagnation temperatures, it does not decompose.

A drainback system requires space for the necessary pitching of collectors and pipes for proper drainage. Also, a nearby heated area must have a room for the pumps and the drainback tank. Plumbing exposed to freezing conditions drains to the drainback tank, making the drainback design unsuitable for sites where the collector cannot be elevated above the storage tank.

Both dynamic and static pressure losses must be considered in drainback system design. Dynamic pressure loss is due to friction in the pipes, and static pressure loss is associated with the distance the water must be lifted above the level of the drainback tank to the top of the collector. There are two distinct designs of drainback systems: the oversized downcomer (or open-drop) and the siphon return. The static pressure requirement remains constant in the open-drop system and decreases in the siphon return.

Drainback performs better than other systems in areas with low temperatures or high irradiance. Drainback has the advantage that time and energy are not lost in reheating a fluid mass left in the collector and associated piping (as in the case of antifreeze systems). Also, water has a higher heat transfer capacity and is less viscous than other heat transfer fluids, resulting in smaller parasitic energy use and higher overall system efficiency. In closed-return (indirect) designs, there is also less parasitic energy consumption for pumping because water is the heat transfer fluid. Drainback systems can be worked on safely under stagnation conditions, but should not be restarted during peak solar conditions to avoid unnecessary thermal stress on the collector.

1.3 SOLAR THERMAL ENERGY COLLECTORS

Collector Types

Solar collectors depend on air heating, liquid heating, or liquid-vapor phase change to transfer heat. The most common type for

commercial, residential, and low-temperature (<95°C) industrial applications is the flat-plate collector.

Liquid-Heating Collectors. Figure 4A shows a cross section of a flat-plate liquid collector. A flat-plate collector contains an absorber plate covered with a black coating and one or more transparent covers. The covers are transparent to incoming solar radiation and relatively opaque to outgoing (long-wave) radiation, but their principal purpose is to reduce convection heat loss. The collector box is insulated to prevent conduction heat loss from the back and edge of the absorber plate. This type of collector can supply hot water or air at temperatures up to 95°C, although efficiency diminishes rapidly above 70°C. The advantages of flat-plate collectors are simple construction, low relative cost, no moving parts, relative ease of repair, and durability. They also absorb diffuse radiation, which is a distinct advantage in cloudy climates.

Another type of collector is the integral collector storage (ICS) system. These collectors incorporate thermal storage within the collector itself. The storage tank surface serves as the absorber surface. Most ICS systems use only one tank, but some use several tanks in series. As with flat-plate collectors, insulated boxes enclose the tanks with transparent coverings on the side facing the sun. Although the simplicity of ICS systems is attractive, they are generally suitable only for applications in mild climates with small thermal storage requirements. Freeze protection by manually draining the unit is necessary in colder climates.

Still another type of collector is the evacuated tube, where the absorber mechanism is encased in a glass vacuum tube (Figure 5). Absorbers may be a simple copper fin tube on a copper sheet, a large copper cylinder in ICS applications, or a heat pipe. The latter uses a phase-change fluid to transfer heat to a common manifold where the working fluid circulates. The vacuum envelope reduces convection and conduction losses, so the tubes can operate at higher temperatures than flat-plate collectors. Like flat-plate collectors, they collect both direct and diffuse radiation. Because of its high-temperature capability, the evacuated-tube collector is favored for energizing heat-driven air-conditioning equipment, particularly when combined with concentrating reflectors behind the tubes.

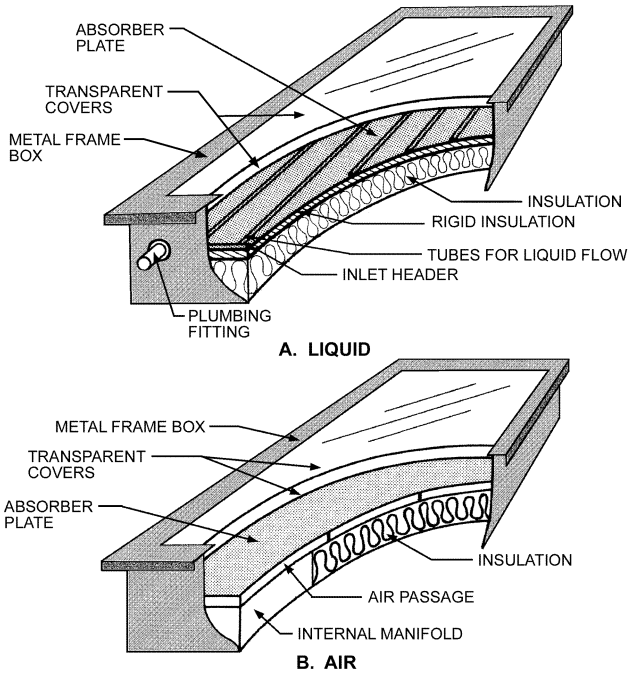


Fig. 4 Solar Flat-Plate Collectors

Flat-plate and evacuated-tube collectors are usually mounted in a fixed position. Concentrating collectors are available that must be arranged to track the movement of the sun. These are mainly used for high-temperature industrial applications above 115°C. For more information on concentrating collectors, see Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Finally, unglazed flat-plate absorbers are often used for low-temperature applications such as pool water heating. The most popular configurations are made of plastic structured to create an almost fully wetted surface or uses very small fins on extruded tubes. Metal absorber plates from glazed collectors are also used, but generally with a heat exchanger to avoid contact with the pool water chemicals.

Air-Heating Collectors. Air-heating collectors are also contained in a box, covered with one or more glazings, and insulated on the sides and back. Figure 4B shows a cross section of a flat-plate air collector. The primary differences from liquid-heating collectors are in the design of the absorber plate and flow passages. Because the working fluid (air) has poor heat transfer characteristics, it flows over the entire absorber plate, and sometimes on both the front and back of the plate, to make use of a larger heat transfer surface. In spite of the larger surface area, air collectors generally have poorer overall heat transfer than liquid collectors. However, they are usually operated at a lower temperature for space heating applications because they require no intervening heat exchangers.

Transpired air collectors can be attached to the roof or side of a building to create a plenum for the preheated air. The collector is simply the siding material with many small holes through which the air is drawn, thus warming the air for space-heating or drying applications.

Liquid-Vapor Collectors. A third class of collectors uses liquid-vapor phase change to transfer heat at high efficiency. These collectors feature a heat pipe (a highly efficient thermal conductor) placed inside a vacuum-sealed tube (Figure 5B). The heat pipe contains a small amount of fluid (e.g., methanol) that undergoes an evaporating/condensing cycle. In this cycle, solar heat evaporates the liquid, and the vapor travels to a heat sink region, where it condenses and releases its latent heat. This process is repeated by a return feed of the condensed fluid back to the solar absorber.

Most phase-change fluids have low freezing temperatures, so the heat pipe offers inherent protection to the tubes from freezing and overheating, but not to the fluid being heated. This self-limiting temperature control is a unique feature of the evacuated heat pipe collector.

Collector Construction

Absorber Plates. The key component of a flat-plate collector is the absorber plate. It contains the heat transfer fluid and serves as a heat exchanger by converting radiant energy into thermal energy. It

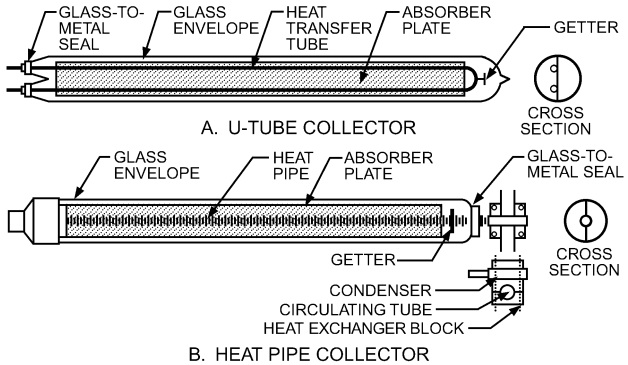


Fig. 5 Evacuated-Tube Collector

must maintain structural integrity at temperatures ranging from below freezing to well above 150°C. Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* illustrates typical liquid collectors and shows the wide variety of absorber plate designs in use.

Materials for absorber plates and tubes are usually highly conductive metals such as copper, aluminum, and steel, although low-temperature collectors for swimming pools are usually made from extruded elastomeric material such as ethylene-propylene terpolymer (EPDM) and polypropylene. Flow passages and fins are usually copper, but aluminum fins are sometimes inductively welded to copper tubing. Occasionally, fins are mechanically attached, but there is potential for corrosion with this design. A few manufacturers produce all-aluminum collectors, but they must be checked carefully to determine whether they incorporate corrosion protection in the collector loop.

Figure 6 shows a plan view of typical absorber plates. The serpentine design (Figure 6A) is used less frequently because it is difficult to drain and imposes a high pressure drop, but it can produce higher temperatures at lower flow rates. Most manufacturers use absorber plates similar to those shown in Figures 6D and 6E.

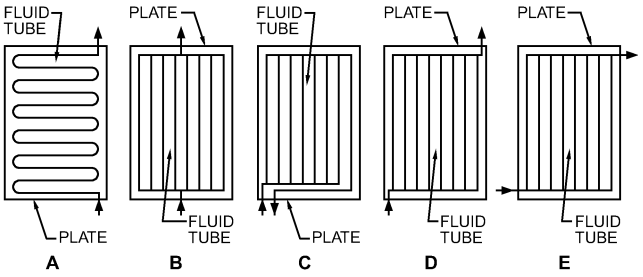


Fig. 6 Plan View of Liquid Collector Absorber Plates

In liquid collectors, manifold selection is important because the design can restrict the array piping configuration. The manifold must be drainable and free-floating, with generous allowance for thermal expansion. Some manufacturers provide a choice of manifold connections to give designers flexibility in designing arrays.

In air collectors, most manufacturers increase the heat transfer area by using fins, matrices, or corrugated surfaces (Figure 7). Many of these designs increase air turbulence, which improves collector efficiency (at the expense of increased fan power).

Figure 7 also shows cross sections of typical solar water collectors. Water passages can be integrated with the absorber plate to ensure good thermal contact (Figure 7E), or they can be soldered, brazed, or otherwise fastened to the absorber plate (Figure 7F). Manufactured collectors are made in modular sizes, typically 910 by 2130 mm, and these are connected to form a bank or row. Because most commercial-scale systems involve more than 100 m^2 of collectors, there can be numerous piping connections, depending on design.

Absorber plates may be coated with spectrally selective or nonselective materials. Selective coatings are more efficient, but cost more than nonselective, or flat black, coatings. However, their higher efficiencies may reduce the overall size of the array, resulting in lower total cost.

Solar collectors with colored absorbers (e.g., blue, red-brown, green) may be aesthetically attractive for building integration. Although colored collectors have lower efficiency than the typical black collectors, the difference in energy output depends on the

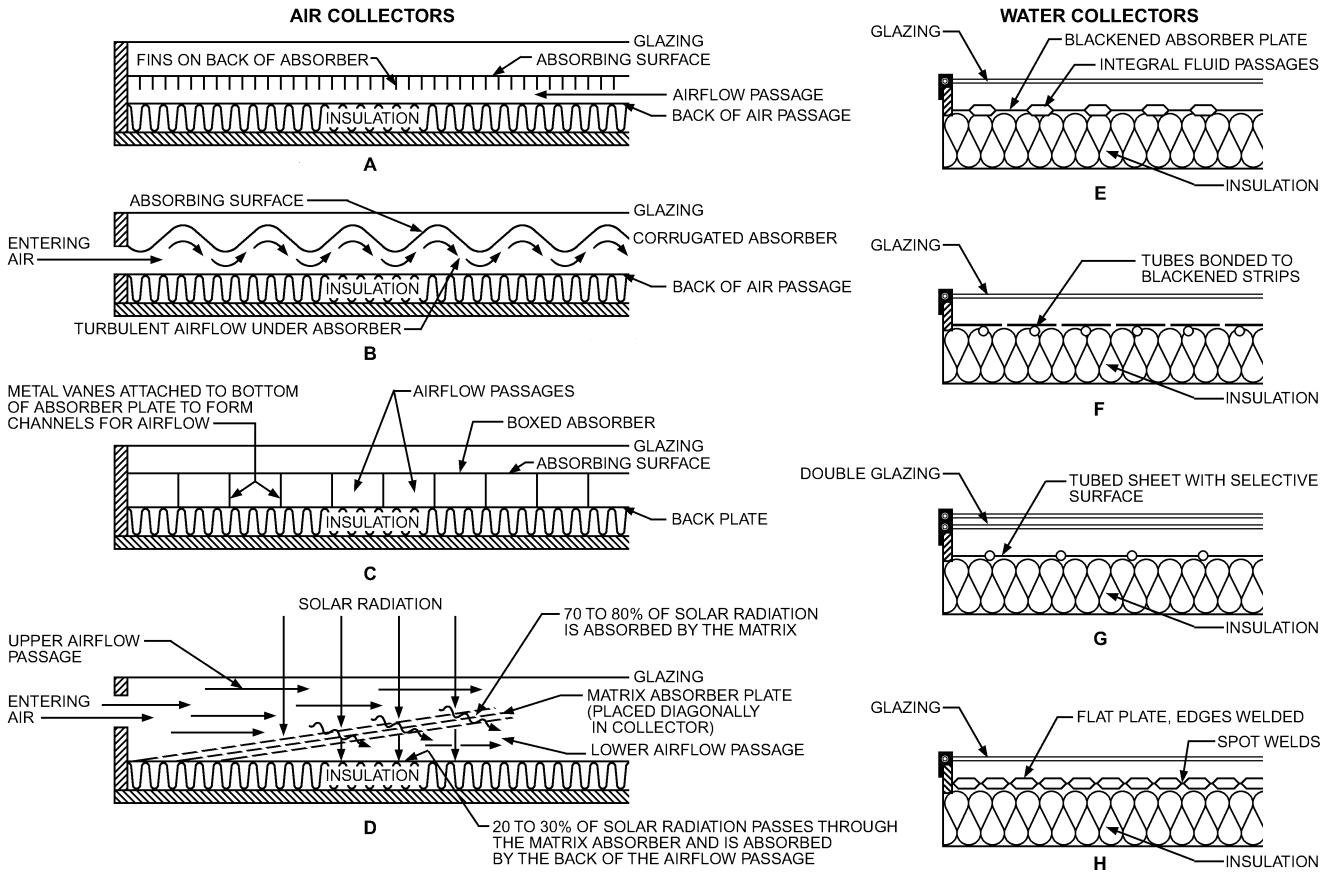


Fig. 7 Cross Sections of Various Solar Air and Water Heater

absorber darkness. For a medium value of the coefficient of absorptance ($\alpha = 0.85$), the drop in amount of energy from colored collectors (about 7 to 18%, depending on location) is satisfactory compared to the performance of collectors with black absorbers ($\alpha = 0.95$). Colored collectors require a proportionately larger collector aperture area to have the same energy output as that of typical black collectors (Kalogirou et al. 2005). Selective colored absorbers are efficient in a wider range of operating temperatures than absorbers with high-emissivity paints, and selective absorbers stable to weather conditions are needed for unglazed collectors to avoid degradation by environmental effects.

Housing. The collector housing is the container that provides structural integrity for the collector assembly. The housing must be structurally sound, weathertight, fire resistant, and mechanically connectable to a substructure to form an array. Collector housing materials include the following:

- Galvanized or painted steel
- Aluminum folded sheet stock or extruded wall materials
- Various plastics, either molded or extruded
- Composite wood products
- Standard elements of the building

Extruded anodized aluminum, including extruded channels, offers durability and ease of fabrication. Grooves are sometimes included in the extruded channels to accommodate proprietary mounting fixtures. The high temperatures of a solar collector deteriorate wood housings; consequently, wood is often forbidden by fire codes.

Glazing. Solar collectors for domestic hot water are usually single-glazed to reduce absorber plate convective and radiative losses. Some collectors have double glazing to further reduce these losses; however, double glazing should be restricted to applications where the value of $(t_i - t_a)/I_t$ exceeds that of domestic hot-water applications (e.g., space heating or activating absorption refrigeration); the parameters for this ratio are defined in Equations (4) and (5). Glazing materials are plastic, plastic film, or glass. Glass can absorb the long-wave thermal radiation emitted by the absorber coating, but it is not affected by ultraviolet (UV) radiation. Because of their impact tolerance, only tempered, low-iron glass covers should be considered. These covers have a solar transmission rating of 84 to 91%.

If the probability of vandalism is high, polycarbonate, which has high impact resistance, should be considered. Unfortunately, its transmittance is not as high as that of low-iron glass, and it is susceptible to long-term UV degradation.

Insulation. Collector enclosures must be well insulated to minimize heat losses. Insulation adjacent to the absorber plate must withstand temperatures up to 200°C and, most importantly, must not outgas volatile products within this range. Many insulation materials designed for construction applications are not suitable for solar collectors because the binders outgas volatiles at normal collector operating temperatures.

Solar collector insulation is typically made of mineral fiber, ceramic fiber, glass foam, plastic foam, or fiberglass. Fiberglass is the least expensive insulation and is widely used in solar collectors. For high-temperature applications, rigid fiberglass board with a minimum of binder is recommended. Also, a layer of polyisocyanurate foam in collectors is often used because of its superior R-value. Because it can outgas at high temperatures, the foam must not be allowed to contact the collector plate.

Figure 8 illustrates the preferred method of combining fiberglass and foam insulation to obtain both high efficiency and durability. Note that the absorber plate should be free-floating to avoid thermal stresses. Despite attempts to make collectors watertight, moisture is always present in the interior. This moisture can physically degrade mineral wool and reduce the R-value of fiberglass, so drainage and venting are crucial.

1.4 ROW DESIGN

Piping Configuration

Most commercial and industrial systems require a large number of collectors. Connecting the collectors with one set of manifolds makes it difficult to ensure drainability, balanced flow, and low pressure drop. An array usually includes many individual groups of collectors, called rows, to provide the necessary flow characteristics. Rows can be grouped into (1) parallel flow or (2) combined series-parallel flow. Parallel flow is the most frequently used because it is inherently balanced, has low pressure drop, and is drainable. Figure 9 illustrates

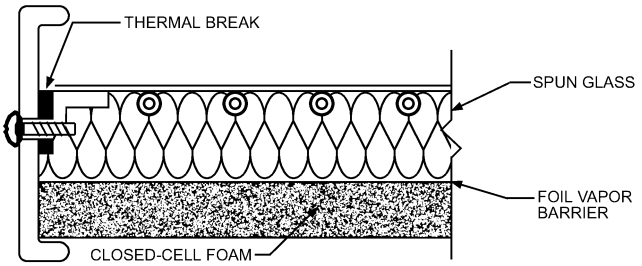


Fig. 8 Cross Section of Suggested Insulation to Reduce Heat Loss from Back Surface of Absorber

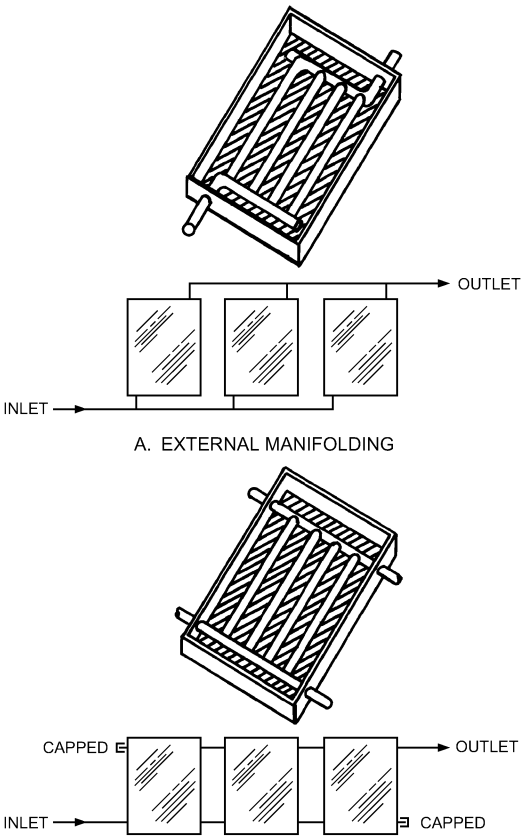


Fig. 9 Collector Manifolding Arrangements for Parallel-Flow Row

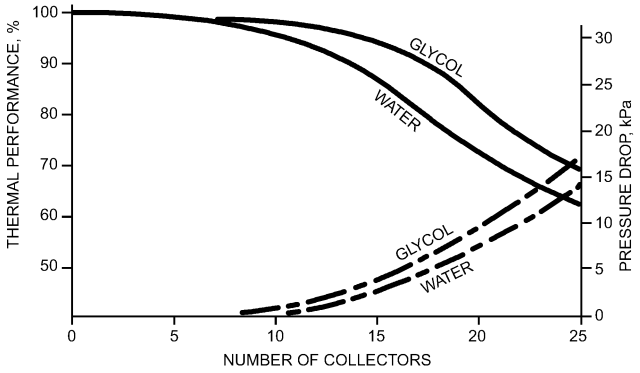


Fig. 10 Pressure Drop and Thermal Performance of Collectors with Internal Manifolds Numbers

various collector header designs for forming a parallel-flow row (the flow is parallel but the collectors are connected in series).

Generally, flat-plate collectors connect to the main piping in one of the methods shown in Figure 9. The **external manifold** collector has a small-diameter connection meant to carry only the flow for one collector. It must be connected individually to the manifold piping, which is not part of the collector panel, as depicted in Figure 9A.

Internal manifold collectors incorporate the manifold piping integral with each collector (Figure 9B). Headers at either end of the collector distribute flow to the risers. Several collectors with large headers can be placed side by side to form a continuous supply and return manifold. With 25 mm headers, four to eight 3.7 m^2 collectors can be placed side by side. Collectors with 25 mm headers can be mounted in a row without producing unbalanced flow. Most collectors have four plumbing connections, some of which may be capped if the collector is located on the end of the array. Internally manifolded collectors have the following advantages:

- Piping costs are lower because fewer fittings and less insulation are required.
- Heat loss is less because less piping is exposed.
- Installation is more attractive.

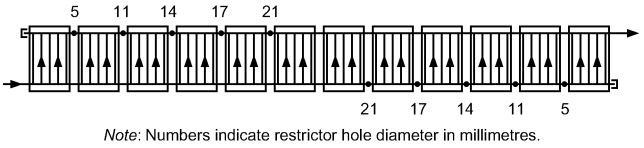
Some of their disadvantages are as follows:

- For drainback systems, the entire row must be pitched, thus complicating mounting.
- Flow may be imbalanced if too many collectors are connected in parallel.
- Removing the collector for servicing may be difficult.
- Stringent thermal expansion requirements must be met if too many collectors are combined in a row.

Velocity Limitations

Fluid velocity limits the number of internally manifolded collectors that can be contained in a row. For 25 mm headers, up to eight 3.7 m^2 collectors can usually be connected for satisfactory performance. If too many are connected in parallel, the middle collectors will not receive enough flow, and performance will decrease. Connecting too many collectors also increases pressure drop. Figure 10 shows the effect of collector number on performance and pressure drop for one particular design. Newton and Gilman (1983) describe a general method to determine the number of internally manifolded collectors that can be connected.

Flow restrictors can be used to accommodate a large number of collectors in a row. The flow distribution in the 12 collectors of Figure 11 would not be satisfactory without the flow restrictors shown at the interconnections. The flow restrictors are barriers with a drilled hole of the diameter indicated. Some manufacturers calculate the required hole diameters and provide predrilled restrictors.



Note: Numbers indicate restrictor hole diameter in millimetres.

Fig. 11 Flow Pattern in Long Collector Row with Restrictions

Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* gives information on sizing piping. Knowles (1981) provides the following expression for the minimum acceptable header diameter:

$$D = 50.4(Q/\Delta p)^{0.45}N^{0.64} \quad (1)$$

where

D = header diameter, mm
N = number of collectors in module
Q = recommended flow rate for collector, L/s
Δp = pressure drop across collector at recommended flow rate, kPa

Because pipe is available in a limited number of diameters, selection of the next larger size ensures balanced flow. Usually, the sizes of supply and return piping are graduated to maintain the same pressure drop while minimizing piping cost. Complicated configurations may require a hydraulic static regain calculation.

Thermal Expansion

Thermal expansion will affect the row shown in Figure 11. Thermal expansion (or contraction) of a module of collectors in parallel may be estimated by the following equation:

$$\Delta = 0.0153n(t_c - t_i) \quad (2)$$

where

Δ = expansion or contraction of collector array, mm
n = number of collectors in array
t_c = collector temperature, °C (generally the maximum stagnation temperature)
t_i = installation temperature of collector array, °C (generally the lowest possible air temperature)

Because absorbers are rigidly connected, the absorber must have sufficient clearance from the side frame to allow the expansion indicated in Equation (2).

1.5 ARRAY DESIGN

Piping Configuration

Liquid Systems. To maintain balanced flow, an array or field of collectors should be built from identical rows configured as described in previous sections. Whenever possible, rows must be connected in reverse-return fashion (Figure 12), which ensures that the array is self balanced. With proper care, an array can drain, which is an essential requirement for drainback freeze protection.

Piping to and from the collectors must be sloped properly in a drainback system. Typically, piping and collectors must slope to drain at 20 mm per linear metre. Elevations throughout the array, especially the highest and lowest point of the piping, should be noted on the drawings.

When freezing is not of a concern, another option is to connect the rows in series (Figure 13). There is some loss in efficiency on each row, but this configuration allows for lower overall flow rates, thus reducing the size of the main supply and return pipes, as well as the size of the pump required. This technique has been used in Europe for large central heating systems to generate the higher temperatures required for absorption air conditioning. Generally, it is

recommended that no more than three rows be put in series, to maintain adequate array performance.

The external manifold collector has different mounting and plumbing considerations from the internal manifold collector (Figure 14). A row of externally manifolded collectors can be mounted horizontally, as shown in Figure 14A. The lower header must be pitched as shown. The pitch of the upper header can be either horizontal or pitched toward the collectors so it can drain back through the collectors.

Arrays with internal manifolds pose a greater challenge in designing and installing the collector mounting system. For these collectors to drain, the entire bank must be tilted, as shown in Figure 14B.

Reverse return always implies an extra pipe run. Sometimes, it is more convenient to use direct return (Figure 15). In this case, balancing valves are needed to ensure uniform flow through the rows. The balancing valves *must* be connected at the row outlet to provide the flow resistance necessary to ensure filling of all rows on pump start-up.

It is often impossible to configure parallel arrays because of the presence of rooftop equipment, roof penetrations, or other building-imposed constraints. Although the list is not complete, the following requirements should be considered when developing the array configuration:

- Strive for a self-balancing configuration.
- For drainback, design rows, subarrays, and arrays to be individually and collectively drainable.
- Always locate collectors or rows with high flow resistance at the outlet to improve flow balance and ensure the drainback system fills.
- Minimize flow and heat transfer losses.

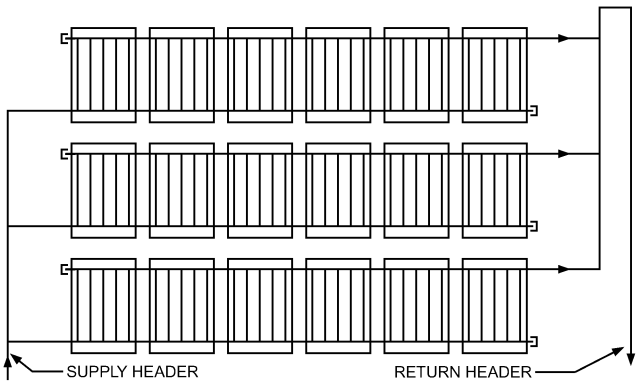


Fig. 12 Reverse-Return Array Piping

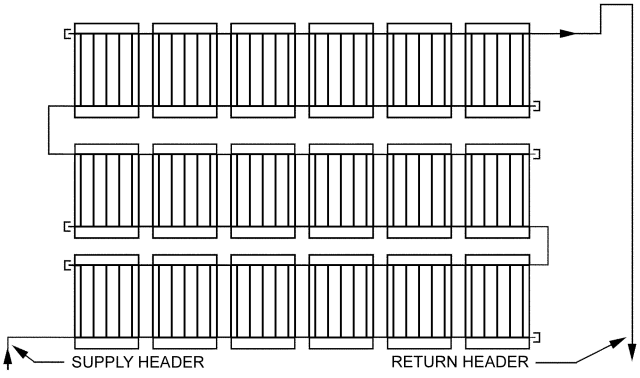


Fig. 13 In-Series Array Piping

In general, it is easier to configure complex array designs for nonfreezing fluid systems. Newton and Gilman (1983) provide some typical examples. However, with careful attention to these criteria, it is also possible to design successful large drainback arrays.

Air Systems. Air distribution within the collector array is the most critical feature of an air system for effective operation. Proper airflow must take into account the overall pressure drop to allow efficient fan motor sizing. Balancing, automatic, backdraft, and fire dampers are usually needed. Air leaks (both into and out of the ducts and from component to component) must be minimized.

For example, some air collector systems contain a water coil for preheating water. Despite the inclusion of automatic and backdraft dampers, leakage within the system can freeze coils. One possible solution is to position the coil near the warm end of the storage bin. Another is to circulate an antifreeze solution in the coil. Whatever the solution, the designer must remember that even the lowest-leakage dampers will leak if improperly installed or adjusted.

As with liquid systems, the main supply and return ducts should be connected in a reverse-return configuration, with balancing dampers on each supply branch to the collector modules. If reverse return is not feasible, the main ducts should include balancing dampers at strategic locations. Here too, having fewer branch ducts reduces balancing needs and costs.

Unlike liquid systems, air collectors can be built on site. Although material and cost savings can be substantial with site-built collectors, extreme care is necessary to ensure long life, low leak-

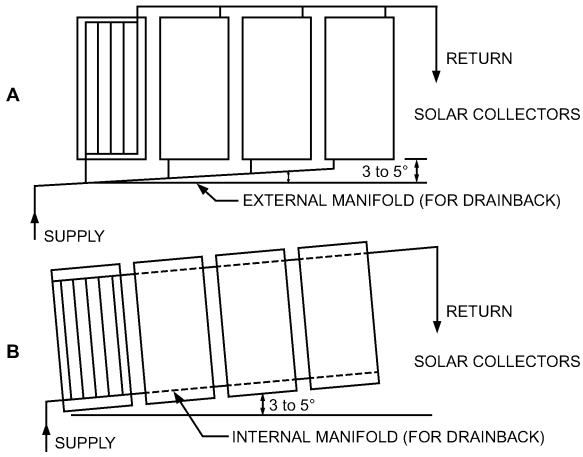


Fig. 14 Mounting for Drainback Collector Modules

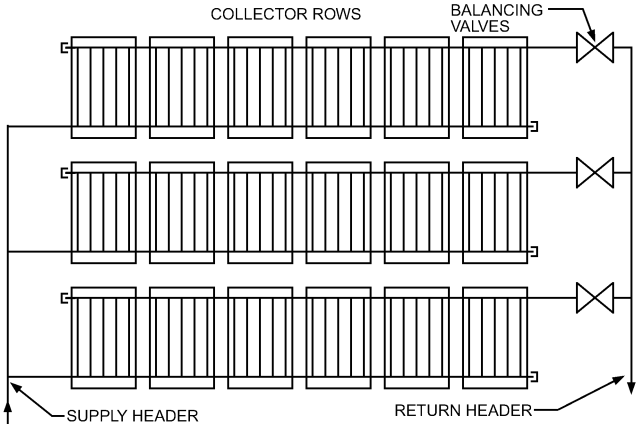


Fig. 15 Direct-Return Array Piping

age, and proper air distribution. Quality control in the field can be a problem, so well-trained designers and installers are critical to the success of these systems.

Performance. The effect of array and air distribution system designs on the overall system performance must be considered. Duffie and Beckman (2013) give standard procedures for estimating the impact of series connection and duct thermal losses. The effect on fan operation and fan power is more difficult to determine. For unique system designs and more detailed performance estimates, including fan power, performance simulation tools can be used.

Shading

When large collector arrays are mounted on flat roofs or level ground, multiple rows of collectors are usually installed in a sawtooth fashion. These multiple rows should be spaced so that they do not shade each other at low sun angles. However, it is usually not desirable to avoid mutual shading altogether. Additional rows can sometimes be added to a roof or other constrained area; this increases the solar fraction but sacrifices efficiency. Kutscher et al. (1982) presents a method of estimating the energy delivered annually when there is some row-to-row shading in the array. The most common practice is to base row spacing on the lowest sun angle during the most important time of the year. For example, water and pool heating systems that operate mostly in the summer can use the higher sun angles of summer or spring and fall. Space-heating systems may want to maximize exposure in the winter, so they should use the lowest sun angle at the winter solstice. A system that operates year round may use the spring equinox sun angle as a reasonable compromise to allow more rows.

1.6 THERMAL COLLECTOR PERFORMANCE

Under steady-state flow conditions, the useful heat delivered by a solar collector is equal to the energy absorbed in the heat transfer fluid minus the direct and indirect heat losses from the surface to the surroundings. This principle can be stated in the following relationship:

$$q_u = A_c[I_t\tau\alpha - U_L(\bar{t}_p - t_a)] \tag{3}$$

where

q_u = useful energy delivered by collector, W
A_c = total aperture collector area, m^2
I_t = irradiance, total (direct plus diffuse) solar energy incident on upper surface of sloping collector structure, W/m^2
τ = transmittance (fraction of incoming solar radiation that reaches absorbing surface), dimensionless
α = absorptance (fraction of solar energy reaching surface that is absorbed), dimensionless
U_L = overall heat loss coefficient, $W/(m^2 \cdot K)$
$\bar{t}_p$ = average temperature of absorbing surface of absorber plate, °C
t_a = atmospheric temperature, °C

Except for average plate temperature $\bar{t}_p$, these terms can be readily determined. For convenience, Equation (3) can be modified by substituting inlet fluid temperature for the average plate temperature, if a suitable correction factor is included. The resulting equation is

$$q_u = F_R A_c[I_t\tau\alpha - U_L(t_i - t_a)] \tag{4}$$

where

F_R = correction factor, or collector heat removal efficiency factor; <1.0
t_i = temperature of fluid entering collector, °C

The heat removal factor F_R can be considered the ratio of the heat actually delivered to that delivered if the collector plate were at a uniform temperature equal to that of the entering fluid. An F_R of 1.0 is theoretically possible if (1) the fluid is circulated at such a high rate that its temperature rise is negligible, and (2) the heat transfer coefficient and fin efficiency are so high that the temperature difference between the absorber surface and the fluid is negligible.

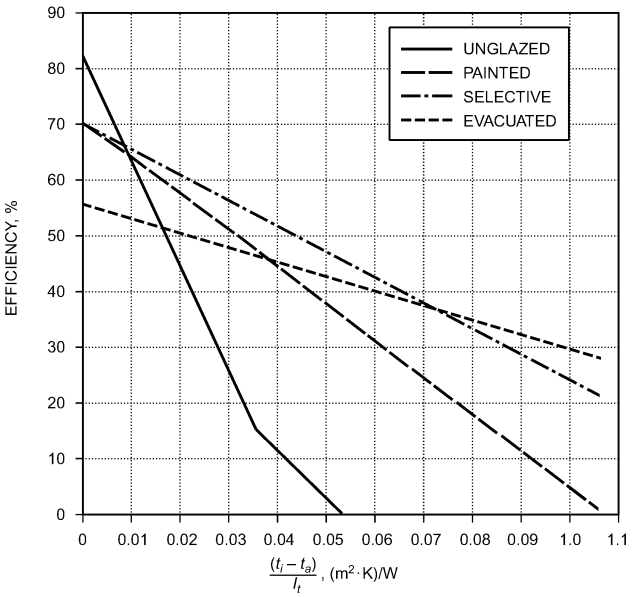


Fig. 16 Solar Collector Type Efficiencies

In Equation (4), the temperature t_i of the inlet fluid depends on the characteristics of the complete solar heating system and the building's heat demand. However, F_R is affected only by the solar collector characteristics, fluid type, and fluid flow rate through the collector.

Solar air heaters remove substantially less heat than liquid collectors. However, their lower collector inlet temperature makes their system efficiency comparable to that of liquid systems for space-heating applications.

Equation (4) may be rewritten in terms of the instantaneous efficiency of total solar radiation collection by dividing both sides of the equation by $I_t A_c$. The result is

$$\eta = F_R\tau\alpha - F_R U_L \frac{(t_i - t_a)}{I_t} \tag{5}$$

where η = collector efficiency, dimensionless.

Equation (5) plots as a straight line on a graph of efficiency versus the heat loss parameter $(t_i - t_a)/I_t$. Plots of Equation (5) for various liquid collectors are shown in Figure 16. The intercept (intersection of the line with the vertical efficiency axis) equals $F_R\tau\alpha$. The slope of the line (i.e., any efficiency difference divided by the corresponding horizontal scale difference) equals $-F_R U_L$. If experimental data on collector heat delivery at various temperatures and solar conditions are plotted, with efficiency as the vertical axis and $(t_i - t_a)/I_t$ as the horizontal axis, the best straight line through the data points correlates collector performance with solar and temperature conditions. The intersection of the line with the vertical axis is where the temperature of the fluid entering the collector equals the ambient temperature, and collector efficiency is at its maximum. At the intersection of the line with the horizontal axis, collection efficiency is zero. This condition corresponds to such a low radiation level, or to such a high temperature of the fluid into the collector, that heat losses equal solar absorption, and the collector delivers no useful heat. This condition, normally called **stagnation**, usually occurs when no coolant flows to a collector. Solving Equation (5)

for t_i under the hottest conditions yields the stagnation temperature for the collectors at that site.

Equation (5) includes all important design and operational factors affecting steady-state performance except collector flow rate and solar incidence angle. Flow rate indirectly affects performance through the average plate temperature. If the heat removal rate is reduced, the average plate temperature increases, and more heat is lost. If the flow is increased, collector plate temperature and heat loss decrease.

Solar Incidence Angle. These relationships assume that the sun is perpendicular to the plane of the collector, which rarely occurs. For glass cover plates, specular reflection of radiation occurs, thereby reducing the $\tau\alpha$ product. The incident angle modifier $K_{\tau\alpha}$, defined as the ratio of $\tau\alpha$ at some incidence angle θ to $\tau\alpha$ at normal radiation $(\tau\alpha)_n$, is described by the following simple expression for specular reflection:

$$K_{\tau\alpha} = \frac{\tau\alpha}{(\tau\alpha)_n} = 1 + b_o\left(\frac{1}{\cos\theta} - 1\right) \tag{6}$$

For a single glass cover, b_o is approximately –0.10. Many flat-plate collectors, particularly evacuated tubes, have some limited focusing capability. The incident angle modifiers for these collectors are not modeled well by Equation (6), which is a linear function of $(1/\cos\theta) - 1$.

Cellular Flow Rate. Equation (5) is not convenient for air collectors when it is desirable to present data based on collector outlet temperature t_{out} rather than inlet temperature, which is the commonly measured variable for liquid systems. The relationship between the heat removal factors for these two cases is

$$F_R\tau\alpha = \frac{(F_R\tau\alpha)'}{1 + (F_R U_L)'/mc_p} \tag{7a}$$

$$F_R U_L = \frac{(F_R U_L)'}{1 + (F_R U_L)'/mc_p} \tag{7b}$$

where mc_p is mass flow times specific heat of air, $F_R U_L$ and $F_R\tau\alpha$ apply to $t_i - t_a$ in Equation (5), and $(F_R U_L)'$ and $(F_R\tau\alpha)'$ apply to $t_{out} - t_a$.

Testing Methods

In the late 1970s, ASHRAE adopted *Standard* 93, Methods of Testing to Determine the Thermal Performance of Solar Collectors, which was a modified version of the procedure published by the National Bureau of Standards (NBS). *Standard* 93 went through regular revisions and updates until 2018, when it was replaced by ISO *Standard* 9806, Solar Thermal Collectors—Test Methods.

ISO *Standard* 9806 gives information on testing solar energy collectors using single-phase fluids (the thermal energy collection process can be separated from the storage one). The data can be used to predict performance in any location and under any conditions where load, weather, and insolation are known.

The standard presents efficiency in a modified form of Equation (5). It specifies that the efficiency be reported in terms of gross collector area A_g rather than aperture collector area A_c. The reported efficiency is lower than the efficiency based on net area, but the total energy collected does not change from this simplification. Therefore, gross collector area must be used when analyzing performance of collectors based on experiments that determine $F_R\tau\alpha$ and $F_R U_L$ according to ISO *Standard* 9806.

Unless otherwise specified, ISO *Standard* 9806 suggests that testing be done at 0.02 kg/s per square metre of gross collector area for liquid systems. For air systems, testing should be done at three values equally distributed between the flow rates of 0.008 and 0.083 kg/s of gross collector area.

For hybrid collectors (e.g. photovoltaic collector with thermal energy recovery [PVT]) generating thermal and electric energy, the mode of electric operation of the PVT collector has a major impact on thermal performance. Thus, ISO *Standard* 9806 suggests that testing be done with the PVT collector maintained within 15% of its maximum power point (MPP).

Annual compilations of collector test data for glazed and unglazed solar collectors may be obtained from Solar Rating and Certification Corporation (www.solar-rating.org). Another source for this information is the collector manufacturer. However, a manufacturer sometimes publishes efficiency data at a much higher flow rate than the recommended design value. In such cases, collector data should be obtained from an independent laboratory.

Collector Test Results and Initial Screening Methods

Final collector selection should be made only after energy analysis of the complete system, including realistic weather conditions and loads, has been completed. Also, a preliminary screening of collectors with various performance parameters should be conducted to identify those that best match the load. One way to accomplish this is to identify the expected range of heat loss parameter $(t_i - t_a)/I_t$ for the load and climate on a plot of efficiency η as a function of heat loss parameter, as indicated in Figure 16.

Ambient temperature during the swimming season may vary by 10 K above or below pool temperature. The corresponding parameter values range from 0.026 W/(m$^2\cdot$K) on cool overcast days (low I_t) to as low as –0.026 W/(m$^2\cdot$K) on hot overcast days. For most swimming pool heating, unglazed collectors offer the highest performance and are the least expensive.

The heat loss parameter for service water heating can range from 0.009 to 0.062 W/(m$^2\cdot$K), depending on the climate at the site and the desired hot-water delivery temperature. Convective space heating requires an even greater collector inlet temperature than water heating, and the primary load coincides with lower ambient temperature. In many areas of the United States, space heating coincides with low radiation values, which further increases the heat loss parameter. However, many space-heating systems are accompanied by water heating, and some space-heating systems (e.g., radiant panels) are available at a lower $(t_i - t_a)/I_t$ value.

Air conditioning with solar-activated absorption equipment is economical only when the cooling season is long and solar radiation levels are high. These devices require at least 80°C water. Thus, on a 27°C day with radiation at 950 W/m^2, the heat loss parameter is 0.05. Higher operating temperatures are desirable to prevent excessive derating of the air conditioner. Only the most efficient (low $F_R U_L$) collector is suitable. Derating may also be minimized by using convective-radiant hybrid air-conditioning systems.

Collector efficiency curves may be used as an initial screening device. However, efficiency curves illustrate only instantaneous performance of a collector. They do not include incidence angle effects (which vary throughout the year); heat exchanger effects; probabilities of occurrence of t_i, t_a, and I_t; system heat loss; or control strategies. Final selection requires determining a collector's long-term energy output and performing cost-effectiveness studies. Estimating a particular collector's and system's annual performance requires appropriate methods such as *f*-Chart (Duffie and Beckman 2013) or performance simulation tools that allow the study of the behavior of transient systems. The Solar Rating and Certification Corporation (SRCC), International Organization for Standardization (ISO), European Committee for Standardization (CEN), and other rating agencies provide day-long collector outputs under various solar and operating conditions. These ratings can greatly simplify selection of the proper collector type, including cost

Table 2 Average Performance* Parameters for Generic Types of Liquid Flat-Plate Collectors

Collector Type	Vertical Intercept	Slope, W/(m²·K)	Clear-Day Category C Output, MJ/m²·day
Unglazed	0.807	–18.68	4.77
Glazed painted absorber	0.701	–6.53	10.53
Selective-surface absorber	0.699	–4.62	11.44
Evacuated tube	0.554	–2.52	9.54

*Derived from data of Solar Rating and Certification Corporation (SRCC), www.solar-rating.org (Oct. 2006).

Table 3 Thermal Performance Ratings* for Generic Types of Liquid Flat-Plate Collectors

	Solar Day, MJ/m²·day		
Category*	22.7 (Clear Day)	17.0 (Mildly Cloudy)	11.4 (Cloudy Day)
Unglazed			
A	18.2	13.6	10.2
B	11.4	7.9	4.5
C	4.5	2.3	—
D	—	—	—
E	—	—	—
Painted			
A	14.6	11.0	7.5
B	12.8	9.3	6.1
C	10.3	6.8	3.2
D	4.6	1.8	—
E	—	—	—
Selective surface			
A	14.9	11.0	7.5
B	13.5	10.0	6.4
C	11.4	7.8	4.3
D	6.8	3.6	0.7
E	2.5	0.4	—
Evacuated tube			
A	9.9	7.4	5.0
B	9.6	7.1	4.6
C	9.2	6.7	4.2
D	7.8	5.3	3.2
E	6.7	4.2	1.8

*Categories	$T_i - T_a$, K	Application
A	–5	Pool heating, warm climate
B	5	Pool heating, cool climate
C	20	Water heating, warm climate
D	50	Water heating, cool climate
E	80	Air conditioning

*Derived from data of Solar Rating and Certification Corporation (SRCC), www.solar-rating.org (Oct. 2006).

considerations. Table 2 shows a comparison of generic types of liquid flat-plate collectors.

Generic Test Results

The generic types of liquid flat-plate collectors are **unglazed**, **single-glazed painted-** and **selective-surface absorbers**, and **evacuated tubes**. Table 2 shows the average output, intercept, and slope for these. The normalized day-long energy output for a clear day in category C points out the difficulties in using only the instantaneous efficiency data. Category C holds the temperature difference constant at 20 K all day, and a clear day is defined as 22.7 MJ/m²·day, which is high for most of the United States. Note that evacuated-tube collectors do not perform very well under these circumstances. SRCC and other rating agencies publish a matrix of collector outputs for various temperature differences and solar days. Table 3 shows the SRCC matrix for each generic collector type. Further explanation of the categories is available on the SRCC website, www.solar-rating.org, or in their standards.

The daily outputs in Table 3 show a clear advantage for each type of collector starting from the upper left corner and proceeding diagonally down and across. At low temperature differences, for categories A and B under clear and mildly cloudy conditions, unglazed collectors provide a clear advantage. The middle of the matrix is a bit less definitive, but painted and selective-surface collectors tend to perform best in the range. At the lower right corner, evacuated tubes perform best under high temperature differences and low solar inputs. Determining where a project falls in this rating matrix is very important in selecting the proper collector; the designer should be familiar with the location's average daily solar input and the desired operating temperature. For example, selective-surface collectors might work well for a high-temperature application in Phoenix in the summer because the daytime temperature difference is low and the solar input is high, whereas evacuated tubes are a better choice in Atlanta.

1.7 THERMAL ENERGY STORAGE

Design and selection of thermal storage equipment is one of the most neglected elements of solar energy systems. In fact, the energy storage system has an enormous influence on overall system cost, performance, and reliability, and its design is highly interactive with that of other system elements (e.g., collector loop, thermal distribution system). Thus, it should be considered within the context of the total system.

Energy can be stored in liquids, solids, or phase-change materials (PCMs). Water is the most frequently used liquid storage medium, although the collector loop may use water, oils, or aqueous glycol as a collection fluid. For service water heating and most building space heating, water is normally contained in some type of tank. Air systems typically store heat in rocks or pebbles, but sometimes use the building's structural mass. Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* and ASHRAE (1991) cover this topic in more detail.

Air System Thermal Storage

The most common storage media for air collectors have been rocks or a regenerator matrix made from concrete masonry units (CMUs). Gravel was widely used as a storage medium because it is plentiful and relatively inexpensive; however, the inherent cost and likelihood of mold growth in humid climates put an end to its use. Other possible media include PCMs, water, and the inherent building mass.

Where large interior temperature swings are tolerable, the building's inherent mass may be sufficient for thermal storage. Designated storage may also be eliminated where the array output seldom exceeds the concurrent demand. Loads requiring no storage are usually the most cost-effective applications of air collectors, and heated air from the collectors can be distributed directly to the space.

Water can be used as a storage medium for air collectors by using a conventional heating coil to transfer heat from the air to the water in the storage tank. Advantages of water storage include compatibility with hydronic heating systems and relative compactness (roughly one-third the volume of pebble beds).

Liquid System Thermal Storage

For units large enough for commercial liquid systems, the following factors should be considered:

- Pressurized versus unpressurized storage
- External versus internal heat exchanger

- Single versus multiple tanks
- Steel versus nonmetallic tank(s)
- Type of service (i.e., service hot water [SHW], building space heating [BSH], or a combination of the two)
- Location, space, and accessibility constraints imposed by architectural limitations
- Interconnect constraints imposed by existing mechanical systems
- Limitations imposed by equipment availability

The following sections present examples of the more common configurations.

Pressurized Storage. Defined here as storage that is open to the city water supply, pressurized storage is preferred for small service water heating systems because it is convenient and provides an economical way of meeting ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* requirements with off-the-shelf equipment. Typical storage size is about 40 to 80 L per square metre of collector area. The largest off-the-shelf water heater is 450 L; however, no more than three or four of these should be connected in parallel. Hence, the largest storage that can be considered with off-the-shelf water heater tanks is about 1350 to 1800 L, and must be compared to a single tank with the additional labor and material to connect them, plus the amount of floor space required. For larger solar hot-water and combined systems, the following concerns are important when selecting storage:

- Higher cost per unit volume of ASME rated tanks in sizes greater than 450 L
- Handling difficulties because of large mass
- Accessibility to locations suitable for storage
- Interfacing with existing SHW and BSH systems
- Corrosion protection for steel tanks

The choice of pressurized storage for medium-sized systems is based on the availability of suitable low-cost tanks near the site. Identifying a suitable supplier of low-cost tanks can extend the advantages of pressurized storage to larger SHW installations.

Storage pressurized at city water supply pressure is not practical for building space heating, except for small applications such as residences, apartments, and small commercial buildings.

With pressurized storage, the heat exchanger is always located on the collector side of the tank. Either the internal or external heat exchanger configuration can be used. Figure 17 illustrates the three main types of internal heat exchanger concepts: immersed coil, wraparound jacket, and tube bundle. Small tanks (less than 450 L) are available with either of the first two heat exchangers already installed. For larger tanks, a large assortment of tube bundle heat exchangers are available that can be incorporated into the tank design by the manufacturer.

Sometimes, more than one tank is needed to meet design requirements. Additional tanks offer the following benefits:

- Added storage volume
- Increased heat exchanger surface
- Reduced pressure drop in the collection loop
- Increased stratification for larger volumes

Disadvantages compared to a single tank of the same volume include the following:

- Higher installation costs
- Greater space requirements
- Higher heat losses (reduced performance)

Figure 18 illustrates the multiple-tank configuration for pressurized storage. The exchangers are connected in reverse-return fashion to minimize flow imbalance. A third tank may be added.

An external heat exchanger provides greater flexibility because the tank and heat exchanger can be selected independently of each other (Figure 19). A drawback to this method is that an additional pump, with its parasitic energy consumption, is required.

When selecting an external heat exchanger for a system protected by a nonfreezing liquid, consider the following factors related to start-up after at least one extremely cold night:

- Freeze-up of the water side of the heat exchanger
- Performance loss due to extraction of heat from storage

For small systems, an internal heat exchanger/tank arrangement prevents the water side of the heat exchanger from freezing. However, the energy required to maintain the water above freezing must be extracted from storage, thereby decreasing overall performance.

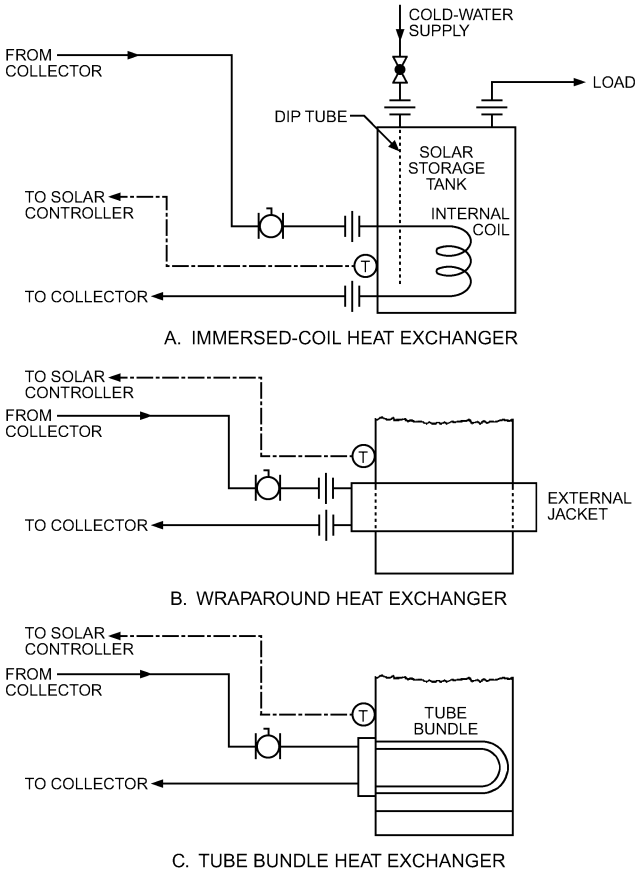


Fig. 17 Pressurized Storage with Internal Heat Exchanger

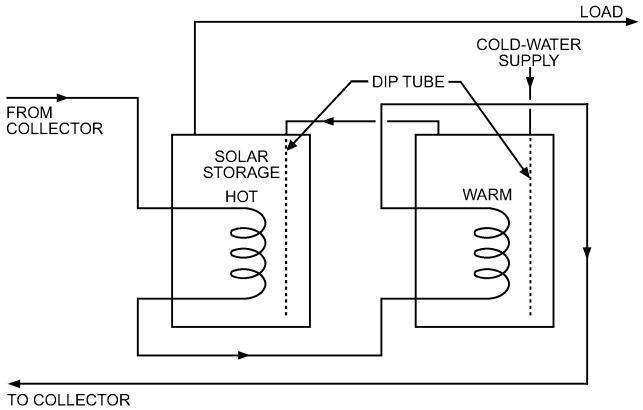


Fig. 18 Multiple Storage Tank Arrangement with Internal Heat Exchangers

With the external heat exchanger/tank combination, a bypass can be arranged to divert cold fluid around the heat exchanger until it has been heated to an acceptable level, such as 27°C. When the heat transfer fluid has warmed to this level, it can enter the heat exchanger without freezing or extracting heat from storage. If necessary, this arrangement can also be used with internal heat exchangers to improve performance. In mild climates where freezing is not an issue, the heat exchanger can be eliminated, thus reducing system cost and complexity.

Unpressurized Storage. For systems greater than about 30 m^3 (5.7 m^3 storage volume minimum), unpressurized storage is usually more cost-effective than pressurized. In this chapter, the term *unpressurized* means tanks at or below the pressure expected in an unvented drainback loop.

Unpressurized storage for water and space heating implies a heat exchanger on the load side of the tank to isolate the high-pressure (potable water) loop from the low-pressure collector loop. Figure 20 illustrates unpressurized storage with an external heat exchanger. In this configuration, heat is extracted from the top of the solar storage tank, and cooled water is returned to the bottom. On the load side of the heat exchanger, water to be heated flows from the bottom of the backup storage tank, and heated water returns to the top. The heat exchanger may have a double wall to protect a potable water supply. A differential temperature controller controls the two pumps on either side of the heat exchanger. If the pumps are small, both may be controlled by the same controller without overloading it.

The external heat exchanger in Figure 20 provides good system flexibility and freedom in component selection. In some cases, system cost and parasitic power consumption may be reduced by an internal heat exchanger. Some field-fabricated heat exchangers use coiled soft copper tube. For larger systems, where custom fabrication is more feasible, a specified heat exchanger can be installed at the top of the tanks.

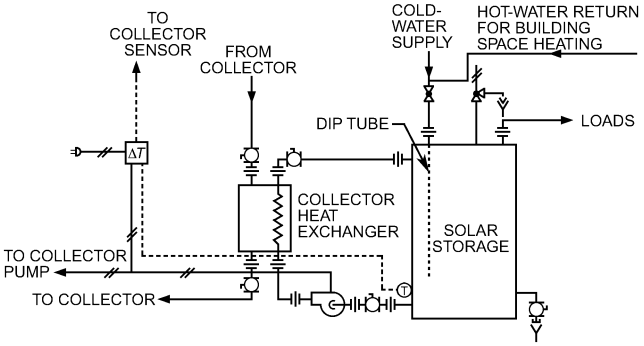


Fig. 19 Pressurized Storage System with External Heat Exchanger

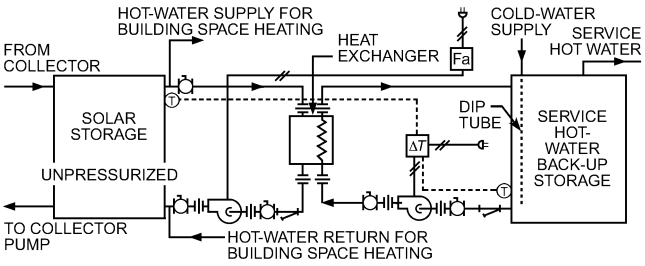


Fig. 20 Unpressurized Storage System with External Heat Exchanger

Storage Tank Construction

Steel. For most liquid solar energy systems, steel is the preferred material for storage tank construction. Steel tanks are relatively easy to fabricate to ASME *Pressure Vessel Code* requirements, readily available, and easily attached to pipes and fittings.

Steel tanks used for pressures of 200 kPa and above must be ASME rated. Because water main pressure is usually above this level, open systems must use ASME code tanks. These pressure-rated storage tanks are more expensive than unpressurized types. Costs can usually be significantly reduced if a unpressurized tank can be used.

Steel tanks are subject to corrosion, however. Because corrosion rates increase with temperature, the designer must be particularly aware of corrosion protection methods for solar energy applications. A steel tank must be protected against (1) electrochemical corrosion, (2) oxidation (rusting), and (3) galvanic corrosion (Cole et al. 1980).

The pH of the liquid and the electric potential of the metal are the primary governing factors of electrochemical corrosion. A sacrificial anode made from a metal more reactive than steel can provide protection. Magnesium is recommended for solar applications. Because protection ends when the anode has dissolved, the anode must be inspected annually.

Oxygen can enter the tank through air dissolved in the water entering the tank or through an air vent. In pressurized storage, oxygen is continually replenished by the incoming water. Besides causing rust, oxygen catalyzes other types of corrosion. Unpressurized storage systems are less susceptible to corrosion caused by oxygen because they can be designed as unvented systems, so corrosion is limited to the small amount of oxygen contained in the initial fill water.

Coatings on the tank interior protect it from oxidation. Some of the most common coatings include the following:

- **Phenolic epoxy** should be applied in four coats.
- **Baked-on epoxy** is preferred over painted-on epoxy.
- **Glass lining** offers more protection than the epoxies and can be used under severe water conditions.
- **Hydraulic stone** provides the best protection against corrosion and increases the tank's heat retention capabilities. Its mass may cause handling problems in some installations.

The coating should either be flexible enough to withstand extreme thermal cycling or have the same coefficient of expansion as the steel tank. In the United States, all linings used for potable water tanks should be approved by the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) for the maximum temperature expected in the tank.

Dissimilar materials in an electrolyte (water) are in electrical contact with each other and corrode by galvanic action. Copper fittings screwed into a steel tank corrode the steel, for example. Galvanic corrosion can be minimized by using dielectric bushings to connect pipes to tanks.

Plastic. Fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) tanks offer the advantages of low mass, high corrosion resistance, and low cost. Premium-quality resins allow operating temperatures as high as 99°C, well above the temperature imposed by flat-plate solar collectors. Before delivery of an FRP tank is accepted, inspect the tank for damage that may have occurred during shipment. The gel coat on the inside must be intact, and no glass fibers should be exposed.

Concrete. Concrete vessels lined with a waterproofing membrane may also be used (in vented systems only) to contain a liquid thermal storage medium. Concrete storage tanks are inexpensive, and can be shaped to fit almost any retrofit application. Also, they have excellent resistance to the loading that occurs when they are placed below grade. Concrete tanks must have smooth corners and edges.

Concrete storage vessels have some disadvantages. Seepage often occurs unless a proper waterproofing surface is applied.

Waterproofing paints are generally unsatisfactory because the concrete often cracks after settling. Other problems may occur because of poor workmanship, poor location, or poor design. Usually, tanks should stand alone and not be integrated with a building or other structure. Pay careful attention to expansion joints and seams because they are particularly difficult to seal. Sealing at pipe taps can be a problem. Penetrations should be above liquid level, if possible.

Finally, concrete tanks are heavy and may be more difficult to support in a proper location. Their mass may make insulating the tank bottom more expensive and difficult.

Storage Tank Insulation

Heat loss from storage tanks and piping is one of the major causes of poor system performance. The average R-value of storage tanks in solar applications is about half the insulation design value because of poorly insulated supports. Different standards recommend various design criteria for tank insulation. Performance requirements for unfired storage tanks are included in the service-water-heating sections of ASHRAE *Standards* 90.1 and 90.2. A 12 h maximum capacity loss of 1 to 2% should be feasible. The following equation can be used to calculate the insulation R-value for this requirement:

$$\frac{1}{R} = \frac{fQ}{A\theta} \frac{1}{(t_{avg} - t_a)} \tag{8}$$

where

R = thermal resistivity of insulation, $(m^2 \cdot K)/W$
f = specified fraction of stored energy that can be lost in time θ
Q = stored energy, J
A = exposed surface area of storage unit, m^2
θ = given time period, s
t_{avg} = average temperature in storage unit, °C
t_a = ambient temperature surrounding storage unit during heating season, °C

The insulation factor $fQ/A\theta$ is found from Table 4 for various tank shapes (Cole et al. 1980).

Most solar water-heating systems use large steel pressure vessels, which are usually shipped uninsulated. Materials suitable for field insulation include fiberglass, rigid foam, and flexible foam blankets. Fiberglass is easy to transport and make fire retardant, but it requires significant labor to apply and seal.

Another widely used insulation consists of rigid sheets of polyisocyanurate foam cut and taped around the tank. Material that is 75 to 100 mm thick can provide 3.5 to 5.3 $(m^2 \cdot K)/W$ insulation value. Rigid foam insulation is sprayed directly onto the tank from a foaming truck or in a shop. It bonds well to the tank surface (no air space between tank and insulation) and insulates better than an equivalent thickness of fiberglass. When most foams are exposed to flames, they ignite and/or produce toxic gases. When located in or adjacent to a living space, they often must be protected by a fire barrier and/or sprinkler system.

Some tank manufacturers and suppliers offer custom tank jackets of flexible foam with zipper-like connections that provide quick installation and neat appearance. Some of the fire considerations for rigid foam apply to these foam blankets.

Tank supports are a major source of heat loss. To provide suitable load-bearing capability, the supports must be in direct contact with the tank wall or attached to it. Thermal breaks must be provided between the supports and the tank (Figure 21). If insulating the tank from the support is impractical, the external surface of the supports must be insulated, and the supports must be placed on insulating material that can support the compressive load. Wood, foam glass, and closed-cell foam can be used, depending on the compressive load.

Table 4 Insulation Factor $fQ/A\theta$ for Cylindrical Water Tanks

Size, m^3	Horizontal Tank Insulation Factor, W/m^2			
	D, L = D	D, L = 2D	D, L = 4D	D, L = 6D
0.95	11.45	10.91	9.62	8.74
1.89	14.42	13.75	15.27	11.01
2.84	16.53	15.74	13.88	12.59
3.8	18.17	17.32	15.27	13.85
5.7	20.82	19.81	17.48	15.87
7.6	22.90	21.83	19.24	17.44
11.4	26.21	24.98	22.02	19.97
15.1	28.86	27.48	24.23	21.99
18.9	31.10	29.62	26.12	23.69
Size, m^3	**Vertical Tank Insulation Factor, W/m^2**			
	D to 3D, L = D	D/2, L = D	D/3, L = D	D/4, L = D
0.30	6.62	5.93	6.78	6.21
0.45	7.54	6.78	7.76	7.13
0.95	9.68	8.64	7.76	9.09
1.89	12.21	10.91	12.49	11.45
2.84	13.97	12.49	14.29	13.12
3.8	15.36	13.75	15.74	14.42
5.7	17.60	15.74	18.01	16.53
7.6	19.34	17.32	19.81	18.17
11.4	22.18	19.81	22.68	20.82
15.1	24.39	21.83	24.98	22.90
18.9	26.28	23.50	26.90	24.67

Stratification and Short Circuiting

Because hot water rises and cold water sinks in a vessel, the pipe to the collector inlet should always be connected to the bottom of the tank. The collector then operates at its best efficiency because it is always at the lowest possible temperature. The return from the collector should always run near the bottom of the tank to encourage stratification and avoid introducing cooler fluid to the top of the tank after a draw occurs. Techniques such as using diffusers and lower flow rates have been developed to reduce destratification of flow returning from the collector. Generally, the better the tank stratification, the better the solar system performs overall. Similarly, the load should be extracted from the top of the tank, and cold makeup water should be introduced at the bottom. Because of increased static pressure, vertical storage tanks enhance stratification better than horizontal tanks.

If a system has a rapid tank turnover or if the buffer tank of the system is closely matched to the load, thermal stratification does not offer any advantages. However, in most solar energy systems, thermal stratification increases performance because temperature differences are relatively small. Thus, any enhancement of temperature differentials improves heat transfer efficiency.

Thermal stratification can be enhanced by the following:

- Using a tall vertical tank
- Situating the inlet and outlet piping of a horizontal tank to minimize vertical fluid mixing
- Sizing the inlets and outlets such that exhaust flow velocity is less than 0.6 m/s
- Using flow diffusers (Figure 22)
- Plumbing multiple tanks in series

Multiple tanks generally yield the greatest temperature difference between cold water inlet and hot water outlet. With the piping/tank configuration shown in Figure 18, the difference can approach

17 K. In addition to the cost of the second tank, the cost of extra footings, insulation, and sensors must be considered. However, multiple tanks may save labor at the site because of their small diameter and shorter length. Smaller tanks require less demolition to install in retrofit (e.g., access through doorways, hallways, and windows).

For additional information on stratification and thermal storage, see Chapter 50.

Storage Sizing

The following specific site factors are related to system performance or cost.

Solar Fraction. Most solar energy systems are designed to produce anywhere from 50 to 90% of the energy required to satisfy the load. If a system is sized to produce less than this, there must be greater coincidence between load and available solar energy. Therefore, smaller, lower-cost storage can be used with low-solar-fraction systems without impairing system performance.

Load Matching. A commercial application's load profile may allow using less storage without incurring performance penalties. For example, a company cafeteria or a restaurant serving large luncheon crowds has its greatest hot-water usage during, and just after midday. Because the load coincides with the availability of solar radiation, less storage is required for carryover. For loads that peak during the morning, collectors can be rotated toward the southeast (in the northern hemisphere), sometimes improving output for a given array.

Storage Cost. If a solar storage tank is insulated adequately, performance generally improves with increased storage volume, but the savings must justify the investment. The cost of storage can be minimized by using multiple low-cost water heaters and unpressurized storage tanks made from materials such as fiberglass or concrete.

Performance and cost relationships between solar availability, collector design, storage design, and load are highly interactive. Furthermore, the designer should maximize investment benefits on an annual basis, rather than for one or two months. Thus, solar energy system performance models combined with economic analysis should optimize storage size for a specific site. Several commercially available pieces of software offer such performance modeling capabilities, including NREL's System Advisor Model (SAM; NREL 2019).

SAM's simplified model represents a one-tank solar water (or glycol) heating system with an auxiliary electric heater. The model allows the user to define a specific site; hot-water load profiles; mains and set temperature profiles; and characteristics of the collector, heat exchanger, and solar tank. A financial model is also incorporated for cost-benefit analysis on residential or commercial applications.

Many hydronic solar energy systems are used with a series-coupled heat pump or an absorption air-conditioning system. In the case of a heat pump, lower storage temperatures, which create higher collector efficiencies, are desirable. In this case, the collector size may be greater than recommended for conventional SHW or hydronic building space heating (BSH) systems. In contrast, absorption air conditioners require much higher temperatures (>80°C) than BSH or hydronic BSH systems to activate the generator (Balaras et al. 2006). Therefore, the storage-to-collector ratio can be much less than recommended for BSH. For absorption air conditioning, thermal energy storage may act as a buffer between the collector and generator, which prevents cycling caused by frequent changes in insolation level.

Seasonal Storage. Installations with large solar collector areas and heat storage capacity could cover 50 to 80% of the total heat demand, or even 100% of the load when coupled with seasonal thermal energy storage (Balaras et al. 2010). A central solar heating plant with seasonal storage (CSHPSS) has three main components (Figure 23): solar collector array, seasonal storage tank, and piping network (Argiriou 1997). Heat produced by the collectors throughout the year is stored in the storage tank. This heat is then used to provide domestic hot water and space heating to the buildings when required. A CSHPSS aims for high solar fractions (50 to 80%). The heat is distributed through a hydraulic pipe network. Although solar radiation has a low power density, which requires a large collector area with small heat losses, the output from a stratified storage has a high power density. CSHPSS is easily combined with existing district heating installations and is three to four times more cost effective compared to common small solar systems.

CSHPSS is suitable for heating loads greater than 500 MWh/year; lower loads have high relative storage costs and large relative storage heat losses. The area to be covered should have a relatively high heat density for district heating to be economical. Low-temperature space heating is preferable for operation at low temperatures, especially of return water in the distribution system. On average, 0.20 to 0.30 m^2 collector area per unit heated floor area and

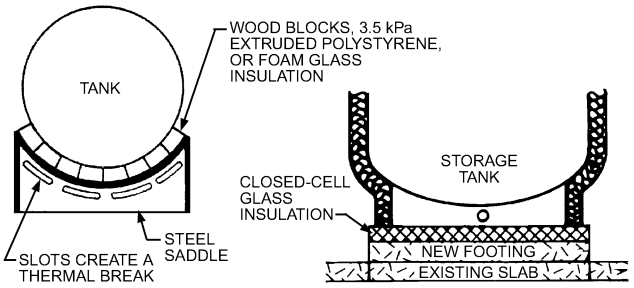


Fig. 21 Typical Tank Support Detail

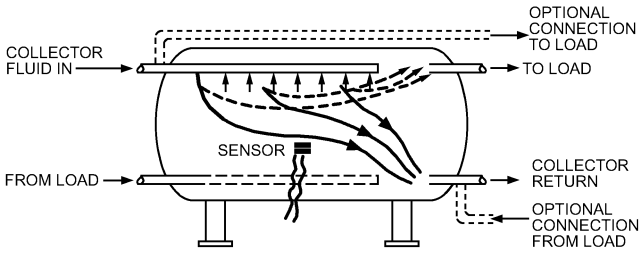


Fig. 22 Tank Plumbing Arrangements to Minimize Short Circuiting and Mixing

(Adapted from Kreider 1982)

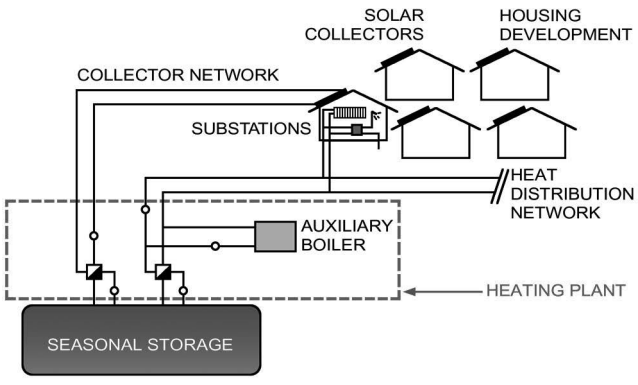


Fig. 23 Schematic of CSHPSS

2 m^3 of storage (water equivalents) per unit collector area are needed to cover 50 to 80% of the total heating load in new buildings.

1.8 HEAT EXCHANGERS

Requirements

The heat exchanger transfers heat from one fluid to another. In closed solar energy systems, it also isolates circuits operating at different pressures and separates fluids that must not be mixed. Heat exchangers are used in solar applications to separate the heat transfer fluid in the collector loop from the domestic water supply in the storage tank (pressurized storage) or the domestic water supply from the storage (unpressurized storage). Heat exchangers for solar applications may be placed either inside or outside the storage or drainback tank.

Selecting a heat exchanger involves the following considerations:

Performance. Heat exchangers always degrade the performance of a solar system; therefore, selecting an adequate size is important. When in doubt, select an oversized heat exchanger.

Guaranteed separation of fluids. Many code authorities require a vented, double-wall heat exchanger to ensure fluid isolation. System protection requirements may also dictate the need for guaranteed fluid separation.

Thermal expansion. The temperature in a heat exchanger may vary from below freezing to the boiling temperature of water. The design must withstand these thermal cycles without failing.

Materials. Galvanic corrosion is always a concern in liquid solar energy systems. Consequently, the piping, collectors, and other hydronic component materials must be compatible.

Space constraints. Often, space for mounting and servicing the heat exchanger is limited. Physical size and configuration must be considered during selection.

Serviceability. The water side of a heat exchanger is exposed to the scaling effects of dissolved minerals, so design must provide access for cleaning and scale removal.

Pressure loss. Energy consumed in pumping fluids reduces system performance. Pressure drop through the heat exchanger should be limited to 7 to 14 kPa to minimize energy consumption.

Pressure capability. Because the heat exchanger is exposed to cold-water supply pressure, it should be rated for pressures above 520 kPa (gage).

Internal Heat Exchanger

The internal heat exchanger can be a coil inside the tank or a jacket wrapped around the pressure vessel (see Figure 17). Several manufacturers supply tanks with either type of internal heat exchanger. However, the maximum size of pressurized tanks with internal heat exchangers is usually about 450 L. Heat exchangers may be installed with relative ease inside unpressurized tanks that open from the top. Figures 24 and 25 illustrate methods of achieving double-wall protection with either type of internal heat exchanger.

For installations with larger tanks or heat exchangers, a tube bundle is required. However, it is not always possible to find a heat exchanger of the desired area that will fit within the tank. Instead, a horizontal tank with the tube bundle inserted from the tank end can be used. A second option is to place a shroud around the tube bundle and to pump fluid around it (Figure 26). This approach combines the performance of an external heat exchanger with the compactness of an internal heat exchanger, but unfortunately it causes tank mixing and loss of stratification.

External Heat Exchanger

Because an external heat exchanger is detached from the tank, it offers greater design flexibility than internal heat exchangers and is preferred for most commercial applications. Shell-and-tube, tube-and-tube, and plate-and-frame heat exchangers are used in solar applications. Shell-and-tube heat exchangers are found in many solar designs because they are economical, easy to obtain, and constructed with suitable material; however, they normally do not have double-wall protection, which is often required for potable-water-heating applications. Several manufacturers produce tube-and-tube heat exchangers that offer high performance and the double-wall safety required by many code authorities, but they are usually limited in size. The plate-and-frame heat exchanger is more cost effective for large potable-water applications where positive separation of heat transfer fluids is required. These heat exchangers are compact and offer excellent heat transfer performance.

Shell-and-Tube. Shell-and-tube heat exchangers accommodate large heat exchanger areas in a compact volume. The number of shell-side and tube-side passes (i.e., the number of times the fluid changes direction from one end of the heat exchanger to the other) is a major variable in selection. Because the exchanger must compensate for thermal expansion, flows in and out of the tube side are generally at the same end of the exchanger. Therefore, the number of tube-side passes is even. By appropriate baffling, two, four, or more tube passes may be created. However, as the number of passes increases, the path length grows, resulting in greater pressure drop

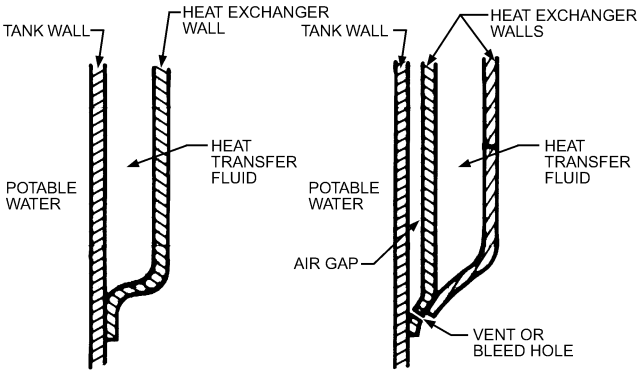


Fig. 24 Cross Section of Wraparound Shell Heat Exchangers

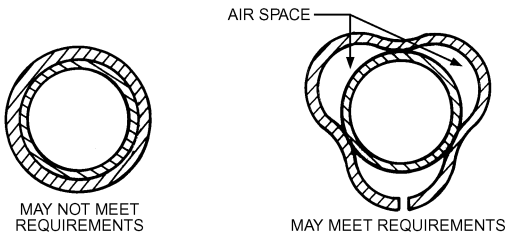


Fig. 25 Double-Wall Tubing

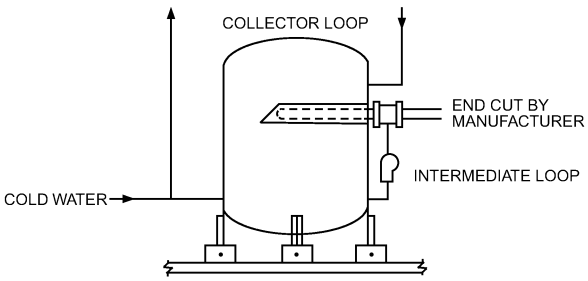


Fig. 26 Tube Bundle Heat Exchanger with Intermediate Loop

of the tube-side fluid. Unfortunately, double-wall shell-and-tube heat exchangers are hard to find.

Tube-and-Tube. Fluids in the tube-and-tube heat exchanger run counterflow, which gives closer approach temperatures. The exchanger is also compact and only limited by system size. Several may be piped in parallel for higher flow, or in series to provide approach temperatures as close as 8 K. Many manufacturers offer the tube-and-tube with double-wall protection.

The counterflow configuration operates at high efficiency. For two heat exchangers in series, effectiveness may reach 0.80. For single heat exchangers or multiple ones in parallel, effectiveness may reach 0.67. Tube-and-tube heat exchangers are cost effective for smaller residential systems.

Plate-and-Frame. These heat exchangers are suitable for pressures up to 2 MPa and temperatures to 200°C. They are economically attractive when a high-quality, heavy-duty construction material is required or if a double-wall heat exchanger is needed for leak protection. Typical applications include food industries or domestic water heating when any possibility of product contamination must be eliminated. This exchanger also gives added protection to the collector loop.

Contamination is not possible when an intermediate loop is used (Figure 27) and the integrity of the plates is maintained. A colored fluid in the intermediate loop gives a visual means of detecting a leak through changes in color. The sealing mechanism of the plate-and-frame heat exchanger prevents cross-contamination of heat transfer fluids. Plate-and-frame heat exchangers cost the same as or less than equivalent shell-and-tube heat exchangers constructed of stainless steel.

Brazed Plate. Brazed-plate exchangers are designed for pressures up to 3 MPa and temperatures up to 260°C. These are similar to plate-and-frame, but without the frame. The edges of the plates are brazed together, creating a compact unit. Brazed plates tend to be on the smaller end of the flow rate spectrum and can be economical for residential and small commercial systems.

Heat Exchanger Performance

Solar collectors perform less efficiently at high fluid inlet temperatures. Heat exchangers require a temperature difference between the two streams to transfer heat. The smaller the heat transfer surface area, the greater the temperature difference must be to transfer the same amount of heat and the higher the collector inlet temperature must be for a given tank temperature. As the solar collector is forced to operate at the progressively higher temperature associated with a smaller heat exchanger, its efficiency is reduced.

In addition to size and surface area, the heat exchanger's configuration is important for achieving maximum performance. The performance of a heat exchanger is characterized by its effectiveness (a type of efficiency), which is defined as follows:

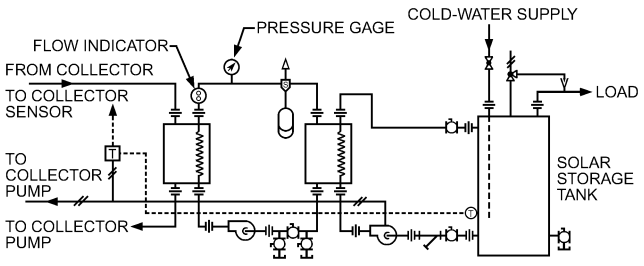


Fig. 27 Double-Wall Protection Using Two Heat Exchangers in Series

$$E = \frac{q}{(mc_p)_{min}(t_{hi} - t_{ci})} \quad (9)$$

where

E = effectiveness
q = heat transfer rate, kW
mc_p = minimum mass flow rate times fluid specific heat, kW/K
t_{hi} = hot (collector-loop) stream inlet temperature, °C
t_{ci} = cold (storage) stream inlet temperature, °C

For heat exchangers located in the collector loop, minimum flow usually occurs on the collector side rather than the tank side.

The effectiveness E is the ratio between the heat actually transferred and the maximum heat that could be transferred for given flow and fluid inlet temperature conditions. E is relatively insensitive to temperature, but it is a strong function of heat exchanger design.

A designer must decide what heat exchanger effectiveness is required for the specific application. A method that incorporates heat exchanger performance into a collector efficiency equation (Equation [5]) uses storage tank temperature t_s as the collector inlet temperature with an adjusted heat removal factor F_R. Equation (10) relates F_R and heat exchanger effectiveness:

$$\frac{F_R'}{F_R} = \frac{1}{1 + (F_R U_L / mc_p)[Amc_p / E(mc_p)_{min} - 1]} \quad (10)$$

The heat exchanger effectiveness must be converted into heat transfer surface area. Franta (1981) provides details of shell-and-tube heat exchangers and heat transfer fluids.

For more information on heat exchangers, see Chapter 47.

1.9 CONTROLS

The brain of an active solar energy system is the automatic temperature control. Numerous studies and reports of operational systems show that faulty controls, usually the sensors, are often the cause of poor performance. Reliable controllers are available, and with a full understanding of each system function, proper control systems can be designed. In general, control systems should be simple; additional controls are not a good solution to a problem that can be solved by better mechanical design. Key considerations for control system design include the following:

- Collector sensor location/selection
- Storage sensor location
- Overtemperature sensor location
- On/off controller characteristics
- Selection of reliable solid-state devices, sensors, controllers, etc.
- Control panel location in heated space
- Connection of controller according to manufacturer's instructions
- Design of control system for all possible system operating modes, including heat collection, heat rejection, power outage, freeze protection, auxiliary heating, etc.
- Selection of alarm indicators for pump failure, low and high temperatures, loss of pressure, controller failure, nighttime operation, etc.

Control categories to consider when designing automatic controls for solar energy systems are as follows:

- Collection to storage
- Storage to load
- Auxiliary energy to load
- Alarms
- Miscellaneous (e.g., for heat rejection, freeze protection, draining, and overtemperature protection)

Types of controllers include snap switches, timers, photovoltaic (PV) modules, and differential temperature controllers. The latter is the most common, with PV popular for residential systems.

Differential Temperature Controllers

Most controls used in solar energy systems are similar to those for HVAC systems. The major exception is the differential temperature controller (DTC), which is the basis of solar energy system control. The DTC is a comparing controller with at least two temperature sensors (typically at the solar collectors and storage tank) that controls one or several devices (Figure 28). On unpressurized systems, other DTCs may control extraction of heat from the storage tank.

The DTC monitors the temperature difference, and when the temperature of the panel exceeds that of the storage by the predetermined amount (generally 4.5 to 11 K), the DTC switches on the actuating devices. When the temperature of the panel drops to 1.5 to 5.5 K above the storage temperature, the DTC, either directly or indirectly, stops the pump. Indirect control through a control relay may operate one or more pumps and possibly perform other control functions, such as actuation of control valves.

The manufacturer's predetermined set point of the DTC may be adjustable or fixed. If the controller set point is a fixed temperature differential, the controller should correspond to the requirements of the system. An adjustable differential set point makes the controller more flexible and allows it to be adjusted to the specific system. The optimum *off* temperature differential should be the minimum possible; the minimum depends on whether there is a heat exchanger between the collectors and storage.

If the system requires a heat exchanger, the energy transferred between two fluids raises the differential temperature set point. The minimum, or *off*, temperature differential is the point at which pumping the energy costs as much as the value of the energy being pumped. For systems with heat exchangers, the *off* set point is generally between 3 and 5.5 K. If the system does not have a heat exchanger, a range of 1.5 to 3.5 K is acceptable for the *off* set point. Heat lost in piping and power required to operate the pump should also be considered.

The optimum differential *on* set point is difficult to calculate because of the changing variables and conditions. Typically, the *on* set point is 5.5 to 8.5 K above the *off* set point. The optimum *on* set point is a balance between optimum energy collection and avoiding short-cycling the pump. ASHRAE's *Active Solar Heating System Design Manual* (1988) describes techniques for minimizing short cycling.

Photovoltaically Powered Pumps

The ability to drive a pump in direct proportion to the available irradiance without an external electric power makes PV pumps very popular in residential applications. Brush pumps powered by DC require additional maintenance, but have proven to be as reliable as their AC counterparts. The lack of larger DC brushless motors has limited adoption of this technology in commercial solar systems. Using PV pumps offers the security of having hot water during power outages. The primary disadvantage is the higher first cost.

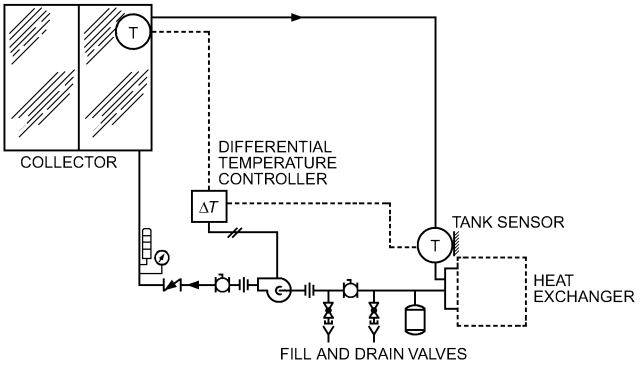


Fig. 28 Basic Nonfreezing Collector Loop for Building Service Hot-Water Heating (Nonglycol Heat Transfer Fluid)

Overtemperature Protection

Overheating may occur during periods of high insolation and low load; thus, all portions of the solar energy system require protection against overheating. Liquid expansion or excessive pressure may burst piping or storage tanks, and steam or other gases in a system may restrict liquid flow, making the system inoperable. Glycols break down and become corrosive if subjected to temperatures greater than 115°C. The system can be protected from overheating by (1) stopping circulation in the collection loop until storage temperature decreases, (2) discharging overheated water from the system and replacing it with cold makeup water, or (3) using a heat exchanger coil as a means of heat rejection to ambient air.

The following questions should be answered to determine whether overtemperature protection is necessary:

- Is the load ever expected to be off, such that the solar input will be much higher than the load? The designer must determine possibilities based on the owner's needs and a computer analysis of system performance.
- Do individual components, pumps, valves, circulating fluids, piping, tanks, and liners need protection? The designer must examine all components and base the overtemperature protection set point on the component that has the lowest specified maximum operating temperature. This may be a valve or pump with an 80 to 150°C maximum operating temperature. Sometimes, this criterion may be met by selecting components that can operate at higher temperatures.
- Is steam formation or discharging boiling water at the tap possible? If the system has no mixing valve that mixes cold water with the solar-heated water before it enters the tap, the water must be maintained below boiling temperature. Otherwise, the water will flash to steam as it exits the tap and, most likely, scald the user. Some city codes require a mixing valve to be placed in the system for safety.

Differential temperature controllers are available that sense overtemperature. Depending on the controller used, the sensor may be mounted at the bottom or the top of the storage tank. If it is mounted at the bottom, the collector-to-storage differential temperature sensor can be used to sense overtemperature. Input to a DTC mounted at the top of the tank is independent of the bottom-mounted sensor, and the sensor monitors the true high temperature.

The normal action taken when the DTC senses an overtemperature is to turn off the pump to stop heat collection. After the panels in a drainback system are drained, they attain stagnation temperatures. Although drainback is not desirable, the panels used for these systems should be designed and tested to withstand overtemperature as well as the thermal shock of start-up when relatively cool water enters the stagnation-temperature panels. The temperature difference can range from 40 to 170 K. Such a difference could warp panels made with two or more materials of different thermal expansion coefficients. If the solar panels cannot withstand the thermal shock, an interlock should be incorporated into the control logic to prevent this situation. One method uses a high-temperature sensor mounted on the collector absorber that prevents the pump from operating until the collector temperature drops below the sensor set point.

If circulation stops in a closed-loop antifreeze system that has a heat exchanger, high stagnation temperatures will occur. These temperatures could break down the glycol heat transfer fluid. To prevent damage or injury caused by excessive pressure, a pressure relief

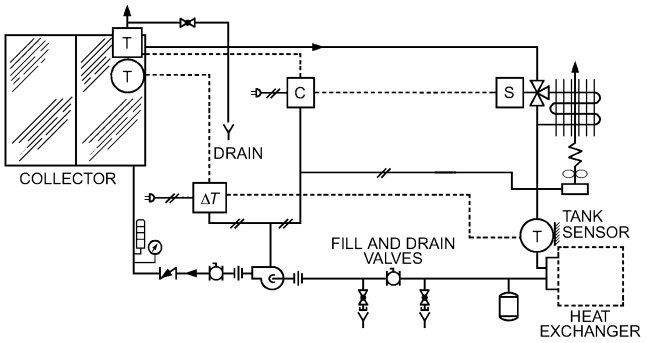


Fig. 29 Heat Rejection from Nonfreezing System Using Liquid-to-Air Heat Exchanger

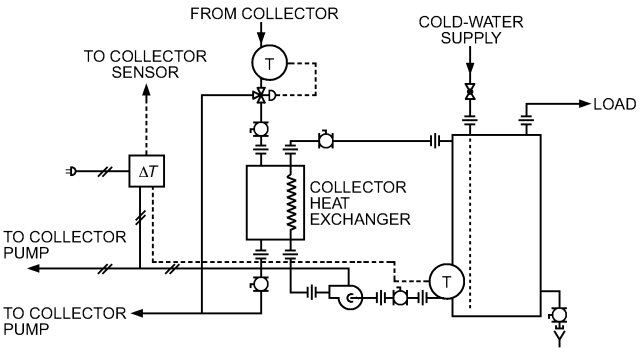


Fig. 30 Nonfreezing System with Heat Exchanger Bypass

valve must be installed in the loop, and a means of rejecting heat from the collector loop must be provided. The section on Hot-Water Dump describes a common way to relieve pressure. Pressure increases because of thermal expansion of any fluid; when water-based absorber fluids are used, pressure builds from boiling.

The pressure-relief valve should be set to relieve at or below the maximum operating pressure of any component in the closed-loop system. Typical settings are around 350 kPa (gage), corresponding to a temperature of approximately 150°C. However, these settings should be checked. When the pressure-relief valve does open, it discharges expensive antifreeze solution. Glycol antifreeze solutions damage many types of roof membranes. The discharge can be piped to large containers to save the antifreeze, but this design can create dangerous conditions because of the high pressures and temperatures involved.

If a collector loop containing glycol stagnates, chemical decomposition raises the liquid's fusion point, and freezing becomes possible. An alternative method continues fluid circulation but diverts flow from storage to a heat exchanger that dumps heat to the ambient air or other sink (Figure 29). This wastes energy, but protects the system. A sensor on the solar collector absorber plate that turns on the heat rejection equipment can provide control. The temperature sensor set point is usually 95 to 120°C and depends on the system components. When the sensor reaches the high-temperature set point, it turns on pumps, fans, alarms, or whatever is necessary to reject the heat and warn of the overtemperature. The dump continues to operate until the overtemperature control in the collector loop DTC senses an acceptable drop in tank temperature and is reset to its normal state.

Hot-Water Dump

If water temperatures above 95°C are allowed, the standard temperature-pressure [99°C, 1034 kPa (gage)] safety relief valve may operate occasionally. If these temperatures are reached, the valve opens, and some of the hot water vents out. However, these valves are designed for safety purposes, and after a few openings, they leak hot water. Thus, they should not be relied on as the only control device. An aquastat that controls a solenoid, pneumatic, or electrically actuated valve should be used instead.

Heat Exchanger Freeze Protection

When selecting an external heat exchanger for a system protected by a nonfreezing fluid and started after an overnight (or longer) exposure to extreme cold, consider the following factors:

- Freeze-up of the water side of the heat exchanger
- Performance loss due to extraction of heat from storage

In small systems, an internal heat exchanger/tank can be placed on the water side of the heat exchanger to prevent freezing. However, the energy required to keep the water above freezing must be extracted from storage, which decreases overall performance. With the external heat exchanger/tank combination, a bypass can be installed (Figure 30). The controller positions the valve to bypass the heat exchanger until the fluid in the collector loop attains a reasonable level (e.g., 27°C). When the heat transfer fluid has warmed to this level, it can enter the heat exchanger without freezing or extracting heat from storage. The arrangement in Figure 30 can also be used with an internal heat exchanger, if necessary, to improve performance.

2. PHOTOVOLTAIC SYSTEMS

Photovoltaic (PV) devices, or cells, convert light directly into electricity. The cells are connected in a combination of series and parallel strings and laminated into modules to produce a nominal maximum voltage and current output when exposed to solar radiation. PV modules can be connected in series, in parallel, or a combination to form arrays that produce larger voltages and/or currents. PV systems rely on sunlight, have no moving parts (unless a solar tracking system is used), are modular to match various power requirements, are reliable, and require minimal maintenance. Photovoltaic systems can be used independently or in conjunction with other electrical power sources.

A typical PV system consists of (1) PV modules, (2) power conversion equipment (e.g., inverters, microinverters, charge controllers, optimizers), (3) balance-of-system (BoS) equipment (e.g., wires, switches, fuses, mounting system), and occasionally (4) a battery bank. In many instances, BoS also refers to all PV system components except the PV modules. PV modules connected in series form a **PV string.** Multiple PV strings connected in series and parallel configurations form a **PV array**. All components are described in the following sections.

Most early PV installations were **stand-alone** systems (i.e., located at sites where utility power was unavailable); applications include communications, remote power, remote monitoring, lighting, water pumping, battery charging, and cathodic protection. These systems may have a battery bank to provide power when the sun is not available. Excess power generated during the day is stored in the battery bank through a charge controller, for later use.

More recently, **grid-connected** (or **grid-tied**) systems have predominated. These systems use string inverters or micro-inverters that convert direct current from the PV array to alternating current. The AC output from the inverters is fed to the AC load circuit. The inverters are designed to synchronize their AC output (phase, frequency, and voltage) with the electric utility. If the grid is down, these systems automatically shut down to prevent backfeeding power into the lines, to protect utility personnel.

Some advanced systems are **grid-interactive** and can function in an isolated mode (when the grid is down) or in a parallel-to-the-grid mode of operation by using grid-interactive inverters. Where energy resiliency and emergency operation are of importance, using these systems is recommended. A typical grid-interactive system incor-

porates battery storage and aims to reduce end-use utility energy consumption, reduce peak power demand, and enhance energy resilience.

Other, less common system configurations connect PV modules directly to an **AC/DC hybrid heat pump**. In this case, no inverter is required: the AC/DC hybrid heat pump can be connected directly to the DC-generating PV array. During the daytime, if the (DC) power generated from the PV is not sufficient, the AC/DC hybrid heat pump draws the additional (AC) power from the electric utility. When the sun is not available, the heat pump is powered only by the utility. Such a configuration can reduce electricity consumption and peak demand for heating and cooling. A drawback is that excess solar electricity is wasted when PV energy production is greater than heat pump energy consumption.

There are also PV systems with thermal energy recovery (PVT). The primary objective of PVT systems is to generate both electricity and thermal energy using the same surface area by recovering part of the heat generated by the PV modules through a heat recovery mechanism. These systems can be either air or water based (or, less frequently, refrigerant based). The main benefit of these systems is that space PVT systems use less surface area than side-by-side thermal and PV systems. More information on the design and performance of PVT systems can be found in Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Fundamentals of Photovoltaics

Photovoltaic Effect. In simple terms, when a photon strikes a PV cell or film, it can be reflected, transmitted through, or absorbed and thus transfer its energy to an electron. This excited electron can reach an established layer of junctions within the cell that was created during the manufacturing process. As electrons reach the junction layer, an electric charge is established between the front and back of the solar cell. Electric contacts placed on the front and back of the cell provide a conduction path for these electrons to flow, creating an electric current.

PV Cells. A PV cell consists of the active PV material, metal grids, antireflection coatings, and supporting material. The complete cell is optimized to maximize both the amount of light entering the cell and the power output of the cell. The photovoltaic material can be one of a number of compounds. Metal grids enhance current collection from the front and back of the solar cell. Grid design varies among manufacturers. The antireflective coating is applied to the top of the cell to maximize the light going into the cell; typically, this coating is a single layer optimized for sunlight. As a result, PV cells range in color from black to blue. In some, the top of the cell is covered with a semitransparent conductor that functions as both the current collector and the antireflection coating. A completed PV cell is a two-terminal device with positive and negative leads, and its output is DC.

In general, all PV cells perform similarly. However, the choice of PV material can have important effects on system design and performance. Both the composition of the material and its atomic structure are influential. PV materials include silicon, gallium arsenide, copper indium diselenide, cadmium telluride, indium phosphide, and many others. The atomic structure of a silicon PV cell can be monocrystalline, polycrystalline, or amorphous (i.e., having no crystalline structure). The most commonly produced PV modules are made of crystalline silicon, either mono- or polycrystalline. The industry distinguishes between cells made with junctions or thin film, made by laminating layers to produce the junctions.

Because of quantum effects, electrons designated to leave their atoms in a PV cell only absorb photon energy of a certain band of wavelengths; the other light energy is not absorbed. Multijunction cells (thin-film with two or more layers of junctions laid on top of one another) can have higher efficiency because each junction layer can be designed to respond to different wavelengths of incoming radiation.

PV Modules. A module is a collection of PV cells that protects the cells and provides a usable operating voltage. Crystalline silicon PV cells can be fragile and susceptible to corrosion by humidity or fingerprints and can have delicate wire leads. Also, the operating voltage of a single PV cell is less than 1 V, making it unusable by itself for many applications. For example, a typical 152 × 152 mm cell operates around 0.5 V and produces approximately 8 A; if 128 cells were wired together in series as one module, then the module would produce approximately 64 V at 8 A, and generate 512 W.

Depending on the manufacturer and type of PV material, modules have different appearances and performance characteristics. Also, modules may be designed for specific conditions, such as hot or marine environments.

Mono and polycrystalline silicon cells are produced individually. Some amorphous silicon cells, although manufactured in large rolls, are later processed as individual cells. These cells are connected in series and parallel to produce the desired operating voltage and wattage. These arrays of cells are then encapsulated with a polymer, a transparent frontsheet (commonly solar, low-iron glass), and a backsheet (glass or polymer). Polymer-encapsulated PV modules can be constructed in a lightweight, flexible (nonrigid) package for building integrated applications.

Cells made of amorphous silicon, cadmium telluride, or copper indium diselenide are manufactured on large rolls of material that become either the frontsheet or the backsheet of the module. A large area of PV material is divided into smaller cells by scribing or cutting the material into electrically isolated cells. Later processing steps automatically interconnect the cells in series and parallel. All modules also include a robust junction box attached to the module for wiring to other modules or other electrical equipment.

Current-Voltage (I-V) Curves. The current from a PV module depends on the external voltage applied and the incident irradiance on the surface of the module. When the module is short-circuited, current is at maximum (short-circuit current I_{sc}), and voltage across the module is zero. When the PV module circuit is open, voltage is at a maximum (open-circuit voltage V_{oc}), and current is zero. In either case, at open or short circuit, the power (current times voltage, $I \times V$) is zero. Between open and short circuit, the power output is greater than zero. A current-voltage (I-V) curve represents the range of combinations of current and voltage (Figure 31).

The power-voltage (P-V) curve can be plotted on the same graph. There exists an operating point at which output power is maximized (P_{mp}), also known as maximum power point (V_{mp}, I_{mp}). Given P_{mp}, an additional parameter, **fill factor (FF)**, can be calculated as

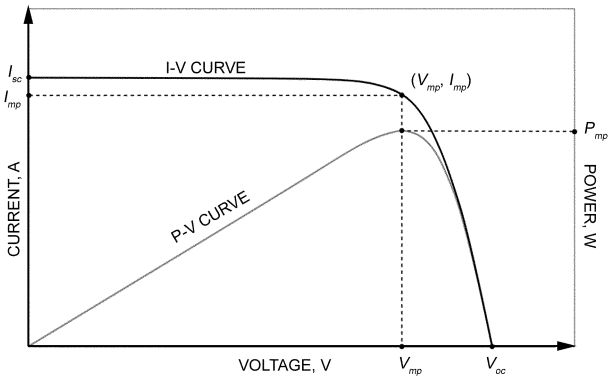


Fig. 31 Representative Current-Voltage and Power-Voltage Curves for Typical Photovoltaic Module

$$P_{mp} = I_{sc}V_{oc}\text{FF} \quad (11)$$

Fill factor is thus defined as the ratio of maximum obtainable power under the I-V curve, to the product of the open-circuit voltage and short-circuit current.

Efficiency and Power. Efficiency is the electrical power output of the module divided by the incident irradiance. It is commonly reported under **standard test conditions (STC)**. These conditions, established by international standard, are defined as 1000 W/m^2 incident irradiation at a spectrum of 1.5 atmospheres equivalent spectral absorption, with a cell temperature of 25°C. PV modules generally convert 5 to 22% of the incident solar radiation into electricity, although the exact percentage varies depending on the photovoltaic technology used and its operating conditions. More information on PV technologies and performance efficiencies can be found in Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Module Reliability and Durability. PV modules are reliable and durable when properly made. As with any electrical equipment, the designer must verify that the product is tested or rated for the intended application. A PV module is a large-area semiconductor with no internal moving parts. Even a concentrator module has no internal moving parts, although there are external parts that keep the module aimed at the sun.

PV modules are designed for outdoor use in harsh surroundings such as marine, tropic, arctic, and desert environments. There are many international standards that test the suitability of PV modules for outdoor use in different climates. A buyer or user should check the suitability of the module for a given climate.

Modules are also tested for electrical safety. All modules have a maximum voltage rating supplied by the manufacturer or labeled on the module. This becomes important when interconnecting several modules into an array and connecting arrays to other electrical equipment. Most modules are tested for ground isolation to prevent personal injury or property damage. To meet the *National Electrical Code*®, modules must be listed by Underwriters Laboratories (UL) or other equivalent testing body.

Module Performance. The performance output of a module is provided by the manufacturer and shown on a label on each module. The value provided is in watts per square metre (W/m^2), and represents the expected nominal power output of the module in watts at STC. Modules are typically marketed and sold by this nominal watt value ($/W). Designers are cautioned that the actual performance of a module under real operating conditions may vary significantly, depending on climatic conditions, air mass, solar spectrum, and solar angle of incidence.

Figure 32 shows that the maximum power P_{mp} occurs only at a single point on the I-V curve, which is the product of the maximum power current I_{mp} and the maximum power voltage V_{mp}. This point is referred to as the **maximum power point (MPP)**.

Off-the-shelf inverters and charge controllers available today use maximum peak-power tracking (MPPT) algorithms to optimize PV power output. Typically, the PV array output wattage is sampled and the voltage is adjusted automatically many times per second for maximum power production. Peak power tracking consumes some of the energy generated by the PV array, though this is typically far less than the extra power gained when compared to a non-power tracking system.

PV modules experience daily variations in light intensity, with the incident solar irradiance varying between 0 W/m^2 (at night) and 1200 W/m^2. The upper limit of daily irradiance varies significantly between different geographic locations, seasons, local climate and PV orientation. Figure 33 shows that current, and therefore power, is proportional to the incident irradiance. The point on the I-V curves indicates the MPP under different irradiance levels.

Solar PV module performance decreases with increasing temperature (Figure 34), in an almost linear manner. The high cell operating temperatures have an effect on the operating voltage and consequently the power output. The operating current is not very sensitive to cell operating temperatures, so it remains relatively constant.

The California Energy Commission requires all modules to be tested for utility scale applications test conditions (PTC), in addition to STC (California Public Utilities Commission 2017). PTC specify 1000 W/m^2 incident irradiation at a spectrum of 1.5 atmospheres equivalent spectral absorption, with an ambient temperature of 20°C. The cell is allowed to reach nominal operating cell temperature (NOCT), which may be 17 to 28 K higher than when tested

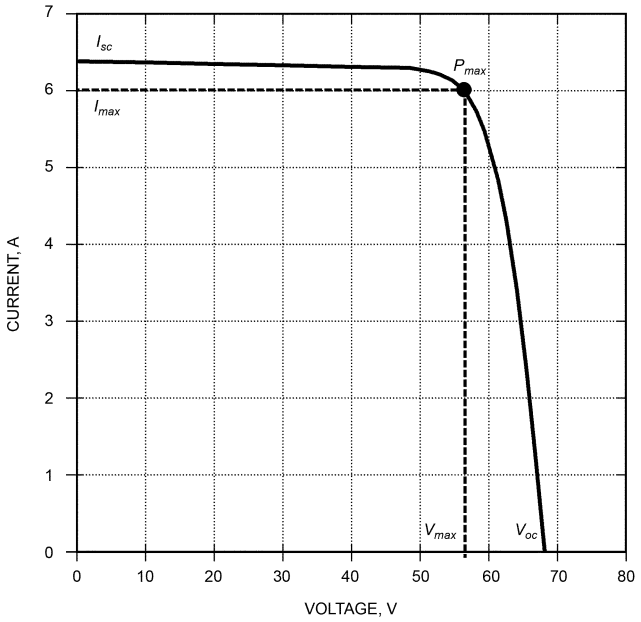


Fig. 32 Module *IV* Curve at STC

(Courtesy SunPower and Khalid Nagidi)

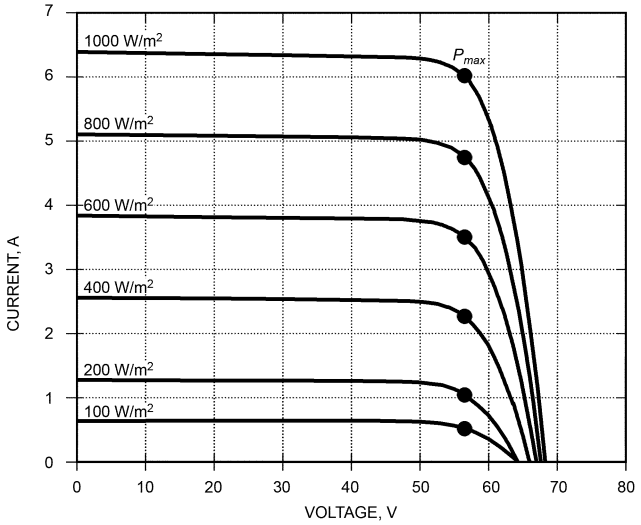


Fig. 33 Effect of Insolation on Module Performance

(Courtesy SunPower and Khalid Nagidi)

under PTC. The lower the NOCT value, the lower the cell temperature, therefore, the higher the PV module performance. PTC give a better indication of actual operating performance; the difference in STC and PTC values indicates the specific module's temperature dependence. The closer the PTC to STC rating, the higher the module output is under more common and realistic operating conditions. The PTC-to-STC ratio is usually between 0.85 and 0.95. Thin-film modules generally have PTC values closer to STC.

All photovoltaic modules experience light-induced degradation (LID). The performance output is provided for new modules with only brief exposure. Modules with crystalline silicon cells experience minimal LID, but thin-film cells can take up to 1000 h of exposure for the initial LID to stabilize. Most thin-film manufacturers rate the modules at the stabilized power output, allowing for an initial period of excess performance. Over 150°C, amorphous silicon modules can undergo thermal annealing, which can reverse the effects of LID (Radue and van Dyk 2010). Improving the stability of thin-film modules over exposure time is an active area of research in the PV industry.

Mono or polycrystalline silicon modules generally exhibit the least power output degradation from exposure, followed by multijunction and single-junction thin-film modules; amorphous cells display the most degradation. Also, note that the performance STC test temperature is 25°C. As cells heat up, their performance declines in a linear manner, about 0.5% per K (for silicon). When selecting equipment for PV systems, it is important to recognize the difference between published cell efficiencies of various types from laboratories and tested module efficiencies. Cell efficiencies may be developed by a lab on small test cells and use short exposure times and may not transfer to the efficiencies of manufactured modules.

Power tolerance indicates how close the PV module actual output would be to its rated output under STC. For example, if a 300 W module has a power tolerance of ±5%, its actual output under STC can fluctuate from 285 W to 315 W. Some PV modules have a positive only power tolerance such as "+5/–0," which means that these modules should be able to produce at least rated power under STC, and possibly 5% more.

Most PV manufacturers provide 25 year power output warranties under STC with an average power output decrease of 0.5% per year. Almost all of them guarantee 90% power output for the first 10 years and 80% thereafter for the remaining 15 years. Few of them now provide 25 year linear power output warranties under STC.

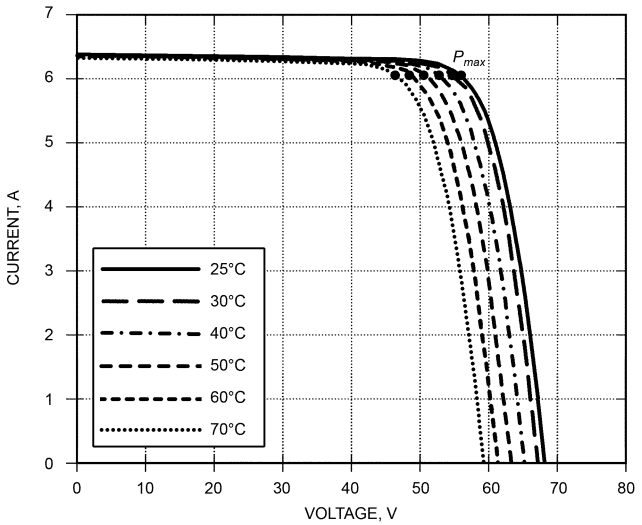


Fig. 34 Effect of Cell Temperature on Module Performance

(Courtesy SunPower and Khalid Nagidi)

Related Equipment

Inverters. An inverter converts DC from the PV arrays to AC. The inverter's output can be single or multiphase, with a voltage of 120, 220, 440, etc., and a frequency of 50 or 60 Hz. Inverters are rated by total power capacity, which ranges from hundreds of watts to megawatts. Some inverters have good surge capacity for starting motors; others have limited surge capacity. The designer should specify both the type and the size of the load the inverter is intended to service.

The output waveform of the inverter, though still AC, can be square, modified square (also called modified sine wave), or sine. For some small applications, modified sine wave inverters are available. Inverters should be selected with care, because equipment that contains silicon-controlled rectifiers (SCRs) or variable-speed motors, such as some vacuum cleaners and laser printers, can be damaged by square- and modified-square-wave inverter outputs. Electric utilities supply sine wave output, and most manufacturers produce inverters with sine wave outputs that avoid unexpected equipment damage. Sine wave inverters generate a waveform very close to that provided by the utility grid. Some can supply AC power that is better regulated and even has lower total harmonic distortion (THD) than utility power.

Inverters can be categorized relative to their interaction with the utility grid. A **stand-alone** inverter is used on off-grid PV systems, and can supply the AC waveform. Commonly, it also provides charge controller capabilities to allow the connection and charge/discharge of a battery bank. A **grid-connected** inverter synchronizes the waveform frequency to the electric utility. All grid-connected inverters must have anti-islanding protection built in so they can be turned off automatically if the utility grid loses power, to protect utility workers from electrical shocks. **Grid-interactive** inverters are grid-connected inverters with advanced capabilities. They can regulate or form their own local grid, thus allowing the PV system to supply the AC load circuit with power for emergency loads, even when the grid is down. They may also provide grid ancillary services at the request of the utility, such as improving voltage or reactive power characteristics.

In addition, inverters can be categorized relative to PV connection configuration (Figure 35). In the case of a **string inverter**, several modules are connected in the form of PV strings or arrays. The current (and power) output of the each PV string is dictated by the current output of the worst performing module. For **microinverters**, each individual PV module has its own microinverter that acts as maximum power point tracker. One benefit of the microinverter is that, because each PV module is individually optimized, modules with different orientations and/or shading may in some cases perform better than an array of modules connected to one inverter.

In addition, microinverters allow both system- and module-level monitoring, whereas string inverters allow only monitoring at the system level. Currently, the capital cost for a microinverter configuration is higher than a string inverter. Another less common configuration is using a string inverter with power optimizers. **Power optimizers** are DC-to-DC converters connected to individual modules, able to optimize the power output of each module. However, a string inverter is still required to convert DC to AC.

Take care to ensure that any PV system complies with local codes and the equipment is certified to the appropriate test and standards, such as those by Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE), Underwriters Laboratories (UL), or California *Rule* 21 (California Public Utilities Commission 2017).

Battery Charge Controllers. Charge controllers regulate the rate at which current is added or drawn from the PV system to the battery bank, thus preventing overcharging. Charge controllers

can be categorized as shunt or series type and can also function as a low-battery-voltage disconnect to prevent battery overdischarge. When the battery bank is full, a shunt charge controller redirects the excess current to a shunt load (e.g., auxiliary electric element) while a series charge controller disconnects the PV system. Often, stand-alone and grid-interactive inverters tend to integrate charge controller circuitry, eliminating the need for a separate charge controller.

Some stand-alone charge controllers use pulse-width modulation (PWM), which allows battery voltage to determine the operating voltage of the PV system. However, battery voltage may not be the optimum PV operating voltage. On the other hand, stand-alone MPPT charge controllers optimize the operating voltage of the PV modules independent of battery voltage so that the PV operates at its MPP. Because the MPP tracker also consumes some of the PV energy to operate, this approach may not always increase the annual generation, especially if the battery and PV arrays are carefully balanced.

A stand-alone charge controller should be selected based on battery voltage (typically 12, 24, or 48 V), V_{oc} and I_{sc} of the PV array, and desired features.

There are four common phases of operating a charge controller:

- **Bulk phase:** the charge controller fills the battery bank from the PV array to approximately 85% of its capacity.
- **Absorption phase:** voltage is maintained at the bulk set point and current is regulated to maintain that voltage.
- **Float phase:** once the battery bank is fully charged, the charging voltage is reduced to the float voltage setting.
- **Equalization:** intentional overcharge of a fully charged battery, which stirs up the electrolyte and evens out its chemical state of charge to keep the battery healthy.

Batteries. Batteries are used in some PV systems to supply power at night or when the PV system cannot meet the demand and to reduce peak power demand and/or enhance energy resilience. The selection of battery type and size depends primarily on load and availability requirements. In all cases, batteries must be located in an area without extreme temperatures and with some ventilation. Designers should be aware that all lead-acid batteries lose their effective energy capacity as the surrounding ambient temperature decreases. For optimal battery performance, battery banks should be kept between 10 and 24°C.

Battery types include lead-acid, nickel cadmium, nickel hydride, lithium, and many others. For a PV system, the main requirement is that the battery be capable of repeated deep discharges without damage. Starting-lighting-ignition batteries (car batteries) are not designed for this and should not be used.

Deep-cycle lead-acid batteries are commonly used. These batteries can be flooded or valve regulated (sealed) and are commercially available in a variety of sizes. Flooded, or wet, batteries require greater maintenance than valve-regulated batteries but can last longer with proper care. For more capacity, batteries can be arranged in parallel, but using more than three strings leads to uneven performance, premature failure of some batteries, and potentially early replacement of the entire battery bank. The rapidly decreasing cost of lithium-nickel-cobalt and lithium-ferrous-phosphate batteries and their ability to operate at higher voltages, as well as charge and discharge rapidly, has made them more common in off-grid PV systems. Utility-sized systems also use them for maintaining output.

Balance-of-System (BOS) Components. These components (e.g., mounting systems, DC and AC wiring, relays, fuses, transformers) are just as important as the other major PV system components. PV systems should be designed and installed with the intent of safety and minimal maintenance, and their installation should not compromise any building envelope warranties. In the United States, wire sizing, insulation, and use of fuses, circuit breakers, and other protective devices are covered by the *National Electrical Code*® (NFPA *Standard* 70).

Photovoltaic modules can be mounted on the ground or on the roof of a building, or can be integrated as part of the building envelope (e.g., facades, windows, overhangs). The latter is usually called **building-integrated photovoltaics (BIPV)**. Numerous state-of-the-art BIPV modules and system solutions are available in the market. The International Energy Agency's Photovoltaic Power Systems Programme (IEA PVPS) Task 15 provides extensive technical information related to BIPV design, testing, certification, and installation (IEA 2019b), and the Solar Energy Application Centre's (SEAC) biennial BIPV status report (SUPSI 2017). Cerón et al. (2013), Jelle et al. (2012), and Norton et al. (2011) review research on enhancing conversion efficiency and economic viability of BIPV systems, along with advances in system design, installation, and operation. Installation of a PV or BIPV system must comply with local electrical, fire, and building codes. More information on the design and performance, operation and maintenance of PV and BIPV systems can be found in Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Solar Tracking Systems. There are three types of solar tracking systems. A **single-axis tracker** follows the sun from east to west with the PV array tilted at a fixed angle. Such a tracker can be a practical and economical solution when used in utility-sized PV systems (>100 MW) and can facilitate snow removal.

A **dual-axis system** tracks the sun from east to west and adjusts the PV array's north/south tilt angle to account for the sun's solar elevation change. An **azimuth tracker** has a fixed slope and rotates around a vertical axis. Proper use of these systems can increase annual solar energy harvest by approximately 30% or more if the site has adequate solar resources. Due to the higher capital and maintenance cost associated with tracking systems and the declin-

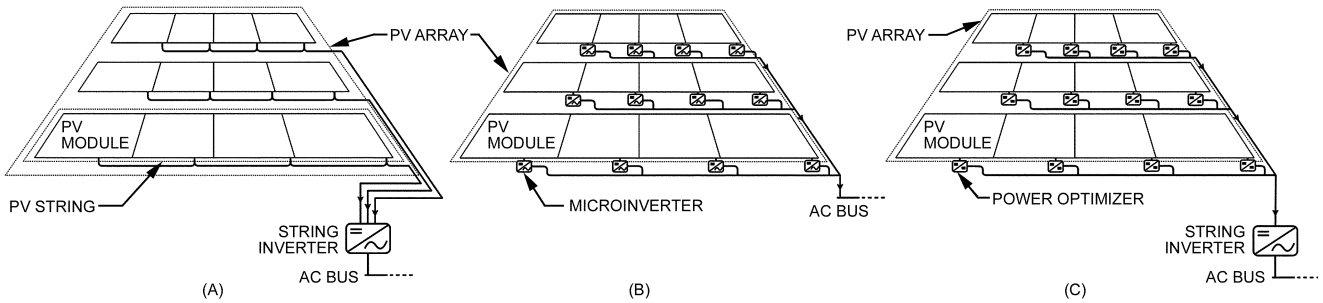


Fig. 35 PV System Configurations Using (A) String Inverter, (B) Microinverters, and (C) String Inverter with Power Optimizers

Source: Natural Resources Canada 2019

ing cost per watt of solar modules, tracking systems are typically used in off-grid and/or mission-critical solar power systems.

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CHAPTER 38

COMPRESSORS

POSITIVE-DISPLACEMENT COMPRESSORS 38.1
Performance 38.2
Abnormal Operating Conditions, Hazards, and Protective Devices 38.4
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RECIPROCATING COMPRESSORS 38.7
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A COMPRESSOR is one of the four essential components of the basic vapor compression refrigeration system; the others are the condenser, evaporator, and expansion device. The compressor circulates refrigerant through the system and increases refrigerant vapor pressure to create the pressure differential between the condenser and evaporator. This chapter describes the design features of several categories of commercially available refrigerant compressors.

There are two broad categories of compressors: positive displacement and dynamic. **Positive-displacement compressors** increase refrigerant vapor pressure by reducing the volume of the compression chamber through work applied to the compressor's mechanism. Positive-displacement compressors include many styles of compressors currently in use, such as reciprocating, rotary (rolling piston, rotary vane, single screw, twin screw, tri screw), and orbital (scroll, trochoidal).

Dynamic compressors increase refrigerant vapor pressure by continuous transfer of kinetic energy from the rotating member to the vapor, followed by conversion of this energy into a pressure rise. Centrifugal compressors function based on these principles.

There are many reasons to consider each compressor style. Some compressors have physical size limitations that may limit their application to smaller capacity equipment; some have associated higher noise; and some have efficiency levels that make them more or less attractive. Each piece of equipment using a compressor has a certain set of design parameters (refrigerant, cost, performance, sound, capacity, etc.) that requires the designer to evaluate various compressor characteristics and choose the best compressor type for the application.

Figure 1 demonstrates the volumetric flow rate of the compressor as a function of the differential pressure (discharge pressure minus suction pressure) against which the compressor is required to work. Three common compressor styles are represented on the chart. Positive-displacement compressors tend to maintain a relatively constant volumetric flow rate over a wide range of differential pressures, given this compressor type draws a predetermined volume of vapor into its chamber and compresses it to a reduced volume mechanically, thereby increasing the pressure. This helps to keep the equipment operating near its design capacity regardless of the conditions. Centrifugal compressors dynamically compress the suction gas by converting velocity energy to pressure energy. Therefore, they do not have a fixed volumetric flow rate, and the capacity can vary over a range of pressure ratios. This tends to make centrifugal-based equipment much more application specific.

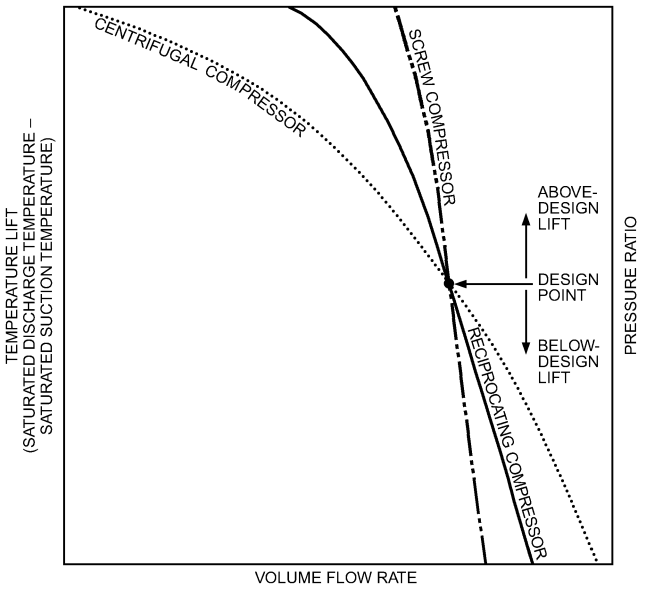


Fig. 1 Comparison of Single-Stage Centrifugal, Orbiting, Reciprocating, and Screw Compressor Performance

1. POSITIVE-DISPLACEMENT COMPRESSORS

Major types of positive-displacement compressors classified by compression mechanism design are shown in Figure 2.

Compressors also can be further classified as single-stage or multistage, and by type of motor drive (electrical or mechanical), capacity control (single speed, variable speed, single speed with adjustable compression chamber volume), and drive enclosure (hermetic, semihermetic, open).

Open-drive compressors are those in which the shaft or other moving part extends through a seal in the crankcase for an external driver. Ammonia compressors are predominantly manufactured only in the open design because of the incompatibility of the refrigerant and common hermetic motor materials. Most automotive compressors are also open-drive type.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.1, Positive Displacement Compressors, and TC 8.2, Centrifugal Machines.

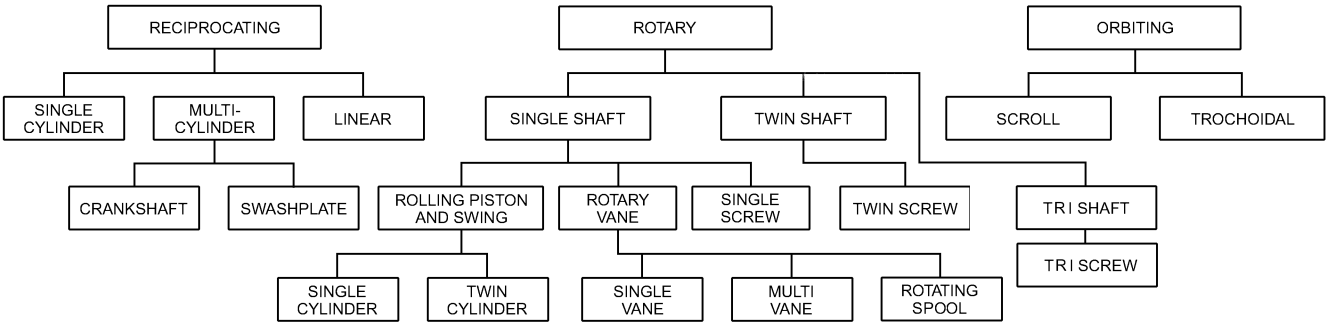


Fig. 2 Types of Positive-Displacement Compressors (Classified by Compression Mechanism Design)

Hermetic compressors contain the motor and compressor in the same refrigerant-tight housing. Hermetic compressors are permanently sealed with no access for servicing internal parts in the field, with the motor shaft integral with the compressor crankshaft and the motor in contact with the refrigerant. Hermetic compressors normally have the motor-compressor pump assembly mounted inside a steel shell, which is sealed by welding.

A **semi-hermetic compressor** (also called bolted, accessible, or serviceable) is a compressor of bolted construction that is amenable to field repair. The seal in the bolted joints is provided by O rings or gaskets. Open-drive compressors are of semi-hermetic construction.

1.1 PERFORMANCE

Compressor performance depends on an array of design compromises involving characteristics of the refrigerant, compression mechanism, and motor. The goal is to provide the following:

- Greatest trouble-free life expectancy
- Most refrigeration effect for least power input
- Lowest applied cost
- Wide range of operating conditions
- Acceptable vibration and sound level

The useful measure of compressor performance is the coefficient of performance (COP). The COP is the ratio of the compressor's refrigerating capacity to the input power. For a hermetic or semi-hermetic compressor, the COP includes the combined operating efficiencies of the motor and the compressor:

$$\text{COP (hermetic or semi-hermetic)} = \frac{\text{Capacity, W}}{\text{Input power to motor, W}}$$

The COP for an open compressor does not include motor efficiency:

$$\text{COP (open)} = \frac{\text{Capacity, W}}{\text{Input power to shaft, W}}$$

Because capacity and motor/shaft power vary with operating conditions, COP also varies with operating conditions.

Power input per unit of refrigerating capacity (W/W) is used to compare different compressors at the same operating conditions, primarily with open-drive industrial equipment.

$$\frac{W_{in}}{W_{out}} = \frac{\text{Power input to shaft, W}}{\text{Compressor capacity, W}}$$

Ideal Compressor

During operation, pressure and volume in the compression chamber vary as shown in Figure 3. There are four sequential processes: first, gas is drawn into the compression chamber during the suction process (1-2); next is compression (2-3); and then higher-pressure gas is pushed out during the discharge process (3-4), followed by the next cycle.

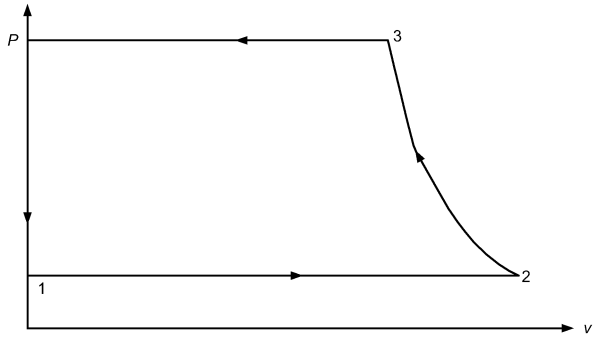


Fig. 3 Ideal Compressor Cycle

The capacity of a compressor at a given operating condition is a function of the mass of gas compressed per unit time. Ideally, mass flow is equal to the product of the compressor displacement per unit time and the gas density, as shown in Equation (1):

$$m = \rho_s V_d \tag{1}$$

where

m = ideal mass flow of compressed gas, kg/s
ρ_s = density of gas entering compressor (at suction port), kg/m^3
V_d = geometric displacement of compressor, m^3/s

The ideal refrigeration cycle, discussed in detail in Chapter 2 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, consists of four processes, as shown in Figure 4:

1–2: isentropic (reversible and adiabatic) compression
2–3: desuperheating, condensing, and subcooling at constant pressure
3–4: adiabatic expansion
4–1: boiling and superheating at constant pressure

The following quantities can be determined from the pressure-enthalpy diagram in Figure 4 using m, the mass flow of gas from Equation (1),

$$Q_o = mQ_{refrigeration\ effect} = m(h_1 - h_4) \tag{2}$$

$$P_{oi} = mQ_{work\ of\ compression} = m(h_2 - h_1) = mw_{oi} \tag{3}$$

where

w_{oi} = specific work of isentropic compression, J/kg
Q_o = ideal capacity, W
P_{oi} = ideal power input, W

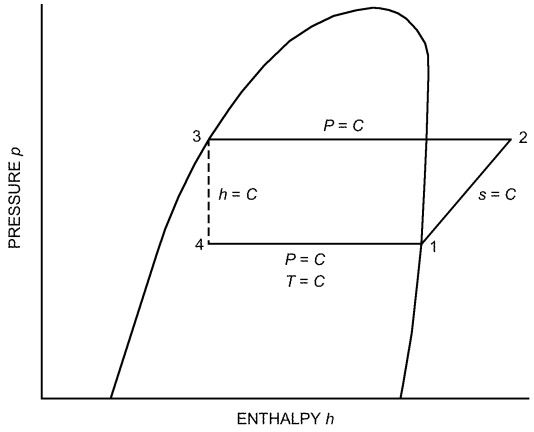


Fig. 4 Pressure-Enthalpy Diagram for an Ideal Refrigeration Cycle

Actual Compressor

Ideal conditions never occur, so actual compressor performance differs from ideal performance. Various factors contribute to decreased capacity and increased power input. Depending on compressor type, some or all of the following factors can have a major effect on compressor performance.

- **Pressure drops in compressor**
  - Through shutoff valves
  - Through suction accumulator
  - Across suction strainer/filter
  - Across motor (hermetic compressor)
  - In manifolds (suction and discharge)
  - Through valves and valve ports (suction and discharge)
  - In internal muffler
  - Through internal lubricant separator
  - Across check valves
- **Heat gain by refrigerant from**
  - Cooling the hermetic motor
  - Internal heat exchange between compressor and suction gas
- **Power losses because of**
  - Friction
  - Lubricant pump power consumption
  - Motor losses
- **Valve inefficiencies** caused by imperfect mechanical action
- **Internal gas leakage**
- **Oil circulation**
- **Reexpansion** (clearance losses)**.** The gas remaining in the compression chamber after discharge reexpands into the compression chamber during the suction cycle and limits the mass of fresh gas that can be brought into the compression chamber.
- **Over- and undercompression.** Overcompression occurs when pressure in the compression chamber reaches discharge pressure before finishing the compression process. Undercompression occurs when the compression chamber reaches the discharge pressure after finishing the compression process.
- **Deviation from isentropic compression.** In the actual compressor, the compression process deviates from isentropic compression primarily because of fluid and mechanical friction and heat transfer in the compression chamber. The actual compression process and work of compression must be determined from measurements.

Compressor Efficiency, Subcooling, and Superheating

Deviations from ideal performance are difficult to evaluate individually. They can, however, be grouped together and considered by category. Their effect on ideal compressor performance is characterized by the following efficiencies:

Volumetric efficiency η_v is the ratio of actual volumetric flow to ideal volumetric flow (i.e., the geometric compressor displacement).

Compression isentropic efficiency η_{oi} considers only what occurs within the compression volume and is a measure of the deviation of actual compression from isentropic compression. It is defined as the ratio of work required for isentropic compression of the gas w_{io} to work delivered to the gas within the compression volume w_a.

$$\eta_{oi} = w_{oi}/w_a \tag{4}$$

For a multicylinder or multistage compressor, this equation applies only for each individual cylinder or stage.

Mechanical efficiency η_m is the ratio of work delivered to the gas (measured) to work input to the compressor shaft w_m.

$$\eta_m = w_a/w_m \tag{5}$$

Isentropic efficiency η_i is the ratio of work required for isentropic compression of the gas w_{oi} to work input to the compressor shaft w_m.

$$\eta_i = w_{oi}/w_m = \eta_{oi}\eta_m \tag{6}$$

Motor efficiency η_e is the ratio of work input to the compressor shaft w_m to work input to the motor w_e.

$$\eta_e = w_m/w_e \tag{7}$$

Total compressor efficiency η_{com} is the ratio of work required for isentropic compression w_{oi} to work input to the motor w_e.

$$\eta_{com} = w_{oi}/w_e = \eta_{oi}\eta_m\eta_e \tag{8}$$

Actual shaft compressor power is a function of the power input to the ideal compressor and the compression, mechanical, and motor efficiencies of the compressor, as shown in the following equation:

$$P_e = P_m/\eta_e = P_a/(\eta_m\eta_e) = P_{oi}/(\eta_{oi}\eta_m\eta_e) \tag{9}$$

where

P_e = power input to motor
P_m = power input to shaft
P_a = power input to the compression mechanism (pump)
P_{oi} = power required for isentropic compression

Actual capacity is a function of the ideal capacity and volumetric efficiency η_v of the compressor:

$$Q = Q_o\eta_v \tag{10}$$

Total heat rejection is the sum of refrigeration effect and heat equivalent of power input to the compressor. Heat radiation or using means for additional cooling may reduce this value. The quantity of heat rejection must be known in order to size condensers.

Note that compressor capacity with a given refrigerant depends on saturation suction temperature (SST), saturation discharge temperature (SDT), superheating (SH), and subcooling (SC). **Saturation suction temperature (SST)** is the temperature of two-phase liquid/gas refrigerant at suction pressure. SST is often called evaporator temperature; however, in real systems, there is a difference

because of pressure drop between evaporator and compressor. **Saturated discharge temperature (SDT)** is the temperature of two-phase liquid/gas refrigerant at discharge pressure. SDT is often called condensing temperature; however, in real systems, there is a difference because of the pressure drop between compressor and condenser.

Liquid subcooling is not accomplished by the compressor. However, the effect of liquid subcooling is included in compressor ratings by some manufacturers. *Note*: Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute (AHRI) *Standard* 540 and European Committee for Standardization (CEN) *European Norm* (EN) 12900 do not include subcooling.

Suction Superheat. In general, no liquid refrigerant should be present in suction gas entering the low-pressure side of the compressor (especially reciprocating and scroll), because it causes oil dilution and gas formation in the lubrication system. If liquid carryover is severe enough to reach the cylinders, excessive wear of valves, valve stops, pistons, and rings can occur; liquid slugging can break valves, pistons, and connecting rods. Measuring suction superheat can be difficult, and the indication of a small superheat (<5 K) does not necessarily mean that liquid is not present. An effective suction separator may be necessary to remove all liquid. In some cases, a small amount of liquid refrigerant in suction gas entering directly to the compression chamber (rotary) may help improve compressor reliability by effectively removing the heat of friction during boundary lubrication or reducing the discharge temperature.

Some compressors are specifically designed to operate without suction superheat. In this case, special design features are introduced to keep liquid from reaching suction valves and cylinders; oil viscosity must also be adjusted to anticipate its dilution with refrigerant.

High suction superheat may result in dangerously high discharge temperatures and, in hermetic compressors, high motor temperatures.

1.2 ABNORMAL OPERATING CONDITIONS, HAZARDS, AND PROTECTIVE DEVICES

To operate through the entire range of conditions for which the compressor was designed and to obtain the desired service life, it is important that mating components in the system be correctly designed and selected. Suction superheat must be controlled, lubricant must return to the compressor, and adequate protection must be provided against abnormal conditions. Chapters 1, 2, 4, and 13 the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* provide more information on protection against abnormal conditions. Chapter 7 of that volume gives details of cleanup in the event of a hermetic motor burnout.

Compressors are provided with one or more of the following devices for protection against abnormal conditions and to comply with various codes.

- **High-pressure protection** as required by Underwriters Laboratories and per AHRI standards and ASHRAE *Standard* 15. This may include the following:
  - A high-pressure cutout (a pressure sensor that sends a signal to the switch to cut power to the compressor motor [drive]).
  - A high- to low-side internal relief valve, external relief valve, or rupture member to comply with ASHRAE *Standard* 15. The differential pressure setting depends on the refrigerant used and operating conditions. Care must be taken to ensure that the relief valve will not accidentally blow on a fast pulldown. Some welded hermetic compressors have an internal high- to low-pressure relief valve to limit maximum pressure in units not equipped with other high-pressure control devices.
- **High-temperature control** devices to protect against overheating and oil breakdown.
  - Motor overtemperature protective devices are addressed in the section on Integral Thermal Protection in Chapter 45.
  - To protect against lubricant and refrigerant breakdown, a temperature sensor is sometimes used to stop the compressor when discharge temperature exceeds safe values. The switch may be placed internally (near the compression chamber) or externally (on the discharge line).
  - On larger compressors, lubricant temperature may be controlled by cooling with a heat exchanger or direct liquid injection, or the compressor may shut down on high lubricant temperature.
  - Where lubricant sump heaters are used to maintain a minimum lubricant sump temperature, a thermostat may be used to limit the maximum lubricant temperature.
- **Low-pressure protection** may be provided for
  - *Suction pressure.* Many compressors or systems are limited to a minimum suction pressure by a protective switch. Motor and compressor mechanism cooling, freeze-up, or pressure ratio usually determine the pressure setting.
  - *Compressor*. Forced-feed lubrication systems use lubricant-pressure, minimum-flow, or minimum-level protectors to prevent the compressor from operating with insufficient lubricant pressure.
- **Time delay or lockouts with manual resets** prevent damage to both compressor motor and contactors from repetitive rapid-starting cycles. Fixed-speed compressor motors experience a significant inrush electrical current during start-up. This current can reach the level of locked rotor amps. If the motor restarts rapidly, without adequate cooling, overheating damage can occur. Time delays should be set for an appropriate interval to avoid this hazard.
- **Low-voltage and phase-loss or reversal protection** is used on some systems. Phase-reversal protection is used with multiphase devices to ensure proper direction of rotation.
- **Suction line strainer.** Some compressors are provided with a strainer at the suction inlet to remove any dirt that might be in suction line piping. Factory-assembled units with all parts cleaned at the time of assembly may not require the suction line strainer. A suction line strainer is normally required in all field-assembled systems.

Liquid Hazard

Liquid is essentially incompressible, so damage may occur when a compressor is handling liquid. This damage depends on the quantity of liquid, frequency with which it occurs, and type of compressor. Slugging, floodback, and flooded starts are three ways liquid can damage a compressor.

Slugging is the short-term pumping of a large quantity of liquid refrigerant and/or lubricant. It can occur just after start-up if refrigerant accumulated in the evaporator during shutdown returns to the compressor. It can also occur when system operating conditions change radically, such as during a defrost cycle. Slugging can also occur with quick changes in compressor loading.

Floodback is the continuous return of liquid refrigerant mixed with suction gas. It is a hazard to compressors that depend on maintaining a certain amount of lubricant for bearing surfaces. A properly sized suction accumulator can be used for protection.

Flooded start occurs when refrigerant is allowed to migrate to the compressor during shutdown. Compressors can be protected with crankcase heaters and automatic pumpdown cycles, where applicable.

Suction and Discharge Pulsations

Suction pulsation occurs because of the sudden flow and slight pressure drop in the suction line at the end of the reverse portion of the cycle and during suction. The frequency of this pulsation corresponds to the frequency of the compression cycle. Amplitude of the pulsation can reach 10 kPa, especially if the compression chamber serves as a resonator. Suction pulsation may affect volumetric efficiency and a propagating compression wave may create structural problems caused by vibration of the suction line and evaporator. Suction pulsation has a negative effect on compressor sound and vibration levels. Specially designed suction mufflers can solve the problems induced by pressure pulsation. Also, a significant volume in the suction line, such as in a suction accumulator, or enclosed by the compressor shell, can reduce pulsation level.

Discharge pulsation occurs because of the sudden flow and pressure fluctuation in the discharge line at the end of the compression portion of the cycle and during discharge. Over- or undercompression has a significant effect on these pulsations. The frequency of the discharge pulsation corresponds to the frequency of the compression cycle. Amplitude of the pulsation can reach more than 100 kPa, especially if the compressor operates with CO_2. In many cases, discharge pulsation is a major contributor to compressor sound and vibration levels. Discharge pulsation can be very destructive (structural damage, damage to sensors, etc.). Discharge mufflers can alleviate the problems induced by pressure pulsation.

Noise

An acceptable sound level is a basic requirement of good design and application. The major contributors to compressor noise are internal turbulence, impact (valves), friction, and the electric motor. Using sound shields or blankets may be feasible in certain applications. Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* covers design criteria in more detail.

Vibration

Compressor vibration results from gas-pressure pulses and inertia associated with moving parts. If the compressor is considered as a cylindrical body, vibration can be differentiated as axial, radial, and torsional. With increase of pressure differential between discharge and suction, vibration increases, especially axial and radial components. At fixed suction and discharge conditions, lower compressor speed usually leads to higher vibration amplitude, especially in the torsional component. Vibration problems can be handled in the following ways.

Isolation. With this common method, the compressor is resiliently mounted in the unit by springs, synthetic rubber mounts, etc. In hermetic reciprocating compressors, the internal compressor assembly is usually spring-mounted within the welded shell, and the entire unit is externally isolated. Use of flexible suction and discharge tubes may be feasible in certain applications.

Amplitude Reduction. The amount of movement can be reduced by adding mass to the compressor. Mass is added either by rigidly attaching the compressor to a base, condenser, or chiller, or by providing a solid foundation. When structural transmission is a problem, particularly with large machines, the entire assembly is then resiliently mounted.

Balancing. Proper balancing of inertial forces is important in reducing vibration. Counterweights are often used in rotary and scroll compressors.

Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* has further information.

Shock

In designing for shock, three types of dynamic loads are recognized:

- Suddenly applied loads of short duration
- Suddenly applied loads of long duration
- Sustained periodic varying loads

Because the forces are primarily inertial, the basic approach is to maintain low equipment mass and make the strength of the carrying structure as great as possible. The degree to which this is done depends on the amount of shock loading.

Commercial Units. The major shock loading to these units occurs during shipment or when they operate on commercial carriers. Train service provides a severe test because of low forcing frequencies and high shock load. Shock loads as high as 100 m/s^2 have been recorded; 50 m/s^2 can be expected.

Trucking service results in higher forcing frequencies, but shock loads can be equal to, or greater than, those for rail transportation. Aircraft service forcing frequencies generally range from 20 to 60 Hz with shocks to 30 m/s^2.

Military Units. Requirements are given in detail in specifications that exceed anything expected of commercial units. In severe applications, deformation of supporting members and shock isolators may be tolerated, provided that the unit performs its function.

Basically, the compressor components must be rigid enough to avoid misalignment or deformation during shock loading. Therefore, structures with low natural frequencies should be avoided.

Testing and Operating Requirements

Compressor tests are of two types: rating (performance) and reliability.

Standard rating conditions, which are usually specified by compressor manufacturers, include the maximum possible compression ratio, maximum operating pressure differential, maximum permissible discharge pressure, and maximum inlet and discharge temperature.

Lubrication requirements, which are prescribed by compressor manufacturers, include the type, viscosity, and other characteristics of the lubricants suitable for use with the many different operating levels and the specific refrigerant being used.

Power requirements for compressor starting, pulldown, and operation vary, because unloading means differ in the many styles of compressors available. Manufacturers supply full information covering the various methods used.

Testing for ratings must be in accordance with ASHRAE *Standards* 23.1 and 23.2.

Manufacturers normally publish performance data at test conditions specified in AHRI *Standards* 520 or 540, or at other industry standard conditions.

Additional compressor tests might address the following characteristics:

- Compressor performance over a range of conditions (performance curves)
- Sound level
- Durability or reliability
- Operational limits (operating envelope)
- Lubrication requirements (oil type, viscosity, amount, etc.)
- Electrical power requirements (start-up current draw, running current measurements, etc.)

Operating envelope shows compressor operating range as a function of saturation suction temperature or suction pressure (SST or SSP) and saturation discharge temperature or pressure (SDT or SDP). An example of the operating envelope is shown in Figure 5.

This envelope is defined by the following extreme condition points:

High load (HL) is defined as intersection of maximum operating SDT or SDP and maximum operating SST or SSP. At this condition, the compressor experiences high power input, high average torque, and high average bearing load.

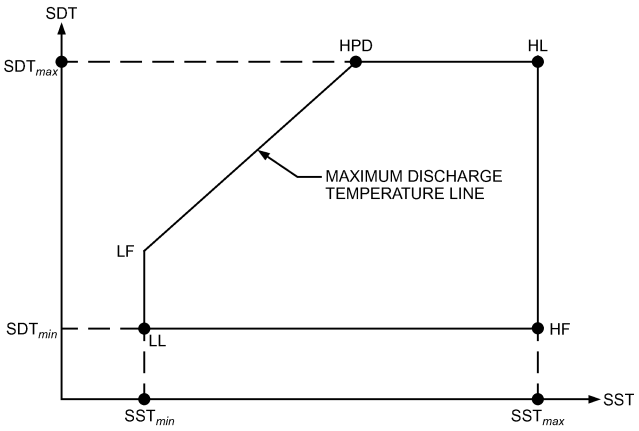


Fig. 5 Example of Compressor Operating Envelope

High flow (HF) is defined as intersection of minimum operating SDT or SDP and maximum operating SST or SSP. At this condition, the compressor experiences high mass flow of the refrigerant and has high cooling capacity.

High pressure differential (HPD) is defined as intersection of maximum operating SDT or SDP and the maximum discharge temperature line. At this condition, the compressor experiences high pressure differential between discharge and suction and the highest allowable discharge temperature.

Low flow (LF) is defined as intersection of the maximum discharge temperature line and minimum operating SST or SSP. The combination of high pressure ratio and low refrigerant flow creates an extreme condition for compressor cooling and oil stability. Cooling capacity at this operating point is the lowest.

Low load (LL) is defined as intersection of minimum operating SDT or SDP and minimum operating SST or SSP. At this point, the compressor experiences low power input and low average torque and bearing load

The common operating range for the air-conditioning SST is –10 to 15°C. The common operating range for the air-conditioning SDT is 25 to 70°C. There are compressor design options that can allow extension of these operating ranges.

Note that compressor capacity (with given refrigerant) depends on SST, SDT, superheating, and subcooling.

1.3 MOTORS

Motors for positive-displacement compressors range from a few hundred watts to megawatts. When selecting a motor for driving a compressor, consider the following factors:

- **Power and rotational speed.**
- **Voltage and number of phases.** Smaller motors are usually 115 or 230 V and single phase. Large motors are usually three phase, 200 to 575 V.
- **Starting and pull-up torques.** Special attention should be paid to starting at extreme hot (highest system pressures) and cold (highest oil viscosity) temperatures. Consideration for system pressures at start-up (whether equalized or differential pressure exists across the compressor) is very important for single-phase compressors; start assist may be required with differential-pressure starting.
- **Ambient and maximum temperature of coolant.** In hermetic and semi-hermetic compressors, the motor is usually cooled by refrigerant flow. This flow can be before suction (low-side compressors) or after discharge (high-side compressors). Note that there is no clear advantage or disadvantage in low- or high-side cooling. In low-side compressors, the motor is efficiently cooled by cold refrigerant returned from the evaporator. The cooler the motor, the higher its efficiency η_e. However, superheated refrigerant after the motor has lower density, which reduces the compressor capacity. In high-side compressors, it is an opposite effect: higher capacity and lower η_e (motor runs hotter). In both cases, the total effect on compressor performance is inconclusive and must be resolved by detailed thermal analysis or testing. Sometimes, selection of motor cooling is dictated by pure reliability or minimum size requirements (e.g., motors bigger than 5 kW usually require low-side cooling to be compact).
- **Cost and availability.**
- **Insulation.** In addition to electrical requirements (dielectric properties, high potential, etc.), motor insulation should be compatible with the refrigerant/oil mixture and should withstand a temperature up to 150°C without losing effectiveness.
- **Efficiency and performance.** The electrical motor performance curves (torque, efficiency, and power factor versus motor speed) must be analyzed against the compressor's operating requirements. For some applications, apparent efficiency (efficiency multiplied by power factor) is important because often the limiting factor is available kilovolt-amperes, not just power (watts).
- **Locked-rotor amps.** This important motor characteristic allows proper selection of motor protection devices or a current breaker. During the start of an AC motor without start assistance or a soft-start package, there is a significant inrush current. The amplitude of this current can be very close to locked-rotor amps. The duration of the inrush is also very important. It must be determined by testing, because it is a function of the individual compressor starting torque and operating speed.
- **Type of protection required** (fuse, internal or external current/temperature switch, etc.). See Chapter 45 for more information.
- **Single-speed, multispeed, variable-speed, or linear.** Single-speed motors can be one, two, or three phase. Multispeed motors contain two or three sets of windings with different number of poles. Motors with two-pole windings provide speed equivalent to the electrical current (e.g., four-pole rotates at half the speed of two-pole). The following equation calculates motor synchronous speed based on electrical frequency and number of poles:

$$\text{Motor speed, rpm} = \frac{120 \times \text{Electrical frequency, Hz}}{\text{Number of poles}}$$

Multispeed motors require relays for switching the windings. These relays can be conventional or solid state (to avoid the effect of vibration).

Variable-speed motors can be AC, brushless DC (BLDC), or permanent magnet AC (PMAC) type. They require a special electrical controller/drive to operate. Any three-phase motor can be considered as an AC variable-speed motor. Control is comparatively simple, but motor efficiency usually does not exceed 90% because of slippage and rotor losses. BLDC and PMAC motors are much more efficient (up to 96%), but their control can be more involved. Permanent magnets are used in the rotors of BLDC and PMAC motors. Some BLDC and PMAC motors require Hall effect sensors or resolvers to identify rotor position, or sensorless technology can be used, which complicates the control. All BLDC and PMAC motors are synchronous, which means that their rotation is proportional to the frequency of the current (i.e., no slip).

Linear motors require a special controller and drive to operate.

- **Location** (high-pressure versus low-pressure side). High-side motors operate at much higher temperature than those on the low side, so their efficiency is noticeably lower. (See the discussion on ambient and maximum coolant temperature previously in this list.)

Although all motors can be started across-the-line, local utilities, local codes, or specification by the end user may require that

motors be started at reduced power levels. These typically include part-winding, wye-delta, double-delta, autotransformer, and solid-state starting methods, all designed to limit inrush starting current. The chosen starting method must supply enough torque to accelerate the motor and overcome the torque required for compression.

Hermetic motors can be more highly loaded than comparably sized open motors because of the refrigerant/oil mixture used for cooling.

For effective hermetic motor application, the maximum design load should be as close as possible to the breakdown torque at the lowest voltage used. This approach yields a motor design that operates better at lighter loads and higher voltage. Overtorqued designs may increase discharge gas temperature at light loads and reduce compressor efficiency.

The single-phase motor presents more design problems than the polyphase, because the relationship between main and auxiliary windings becomes critical. Sometimes it is necessary to use starting equipment in this case.

The rate of temperature rise at the locked-rotor condition must be kept low enough to prevent excessive motor temperature with the motor protection available. The maximum temperature under these conditions should be held within the limits of the materials used. With better protection (and improved materials), a higher rate of rise can be tolerated, and a less expensive motor can be used.

Some types of hermetic motors commonly selected for various applications are as follows:

Small refrigeration compressors (single-phase)

Low to medium torque—Split-phase or PSC (permanent split-capacitor)

High torque—CSCR (capacitor-start/capacitor-run) and CSIR (capacitor-start/induction-run)

Room air conditioner compressors (single-phase)

PSC or CSCR

Two-speed (pole-switching) or variable-speed

Central air conditioning and commercial refrigeration

Single-phase, PSC and CSCR to 4500 W

Three-phase, 1500 W and above, across-the-line start

7500 W and above; part-winding; wye-delta, double-delta, and across-the-line start

Two-speed (pole-switching) or variable-speed

Electronically commutated DC motors (ECMs)

For further information on motors and motor protection, see Chapter 45. Also see Chapter 57 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more on motor-starting effects.

2. RECIPROCATING COMPRESSORS

Table 1 lists typical design features of reciprocating compressors.

Most reciprocating compressors are single acting, using pistons that are driven directly through a wrist pin and connecting rod from the crankshaft. Double-acting compressors that use piston rods, crossheads, stuffing boxes, and oil injection are not used extensively and, therefore, are not covered here. Figures 6 and 7 show the basic structure and pumping cycle for a typical reciprocating compressor piston. Figures 8 and 9 show typical designs of multicylinder reciprocating compressors.

Single-stage compressors are primarily used for medium temperatures (–20 to 0°C) and in air-conditioning applications, but can achieve temperatures below –35°C for refrigeration applications with suitable refrigerants. Chapters 1 and 2 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* have information on other halocarbon and ammonia systems.

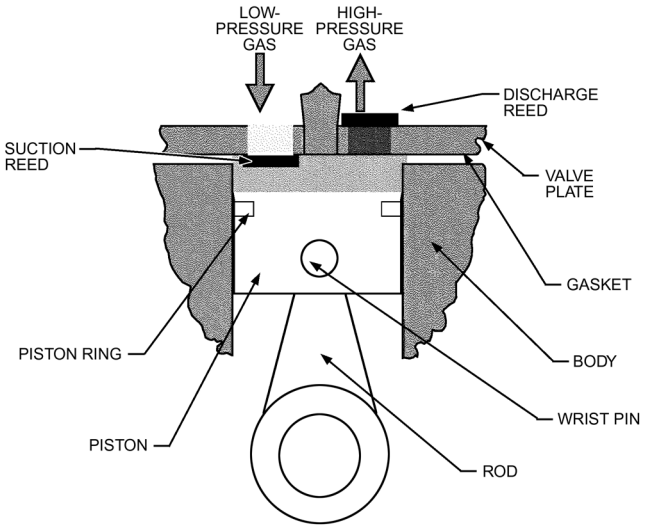


Fig. 6 Basic Reciprocating Piston with Reed Valves

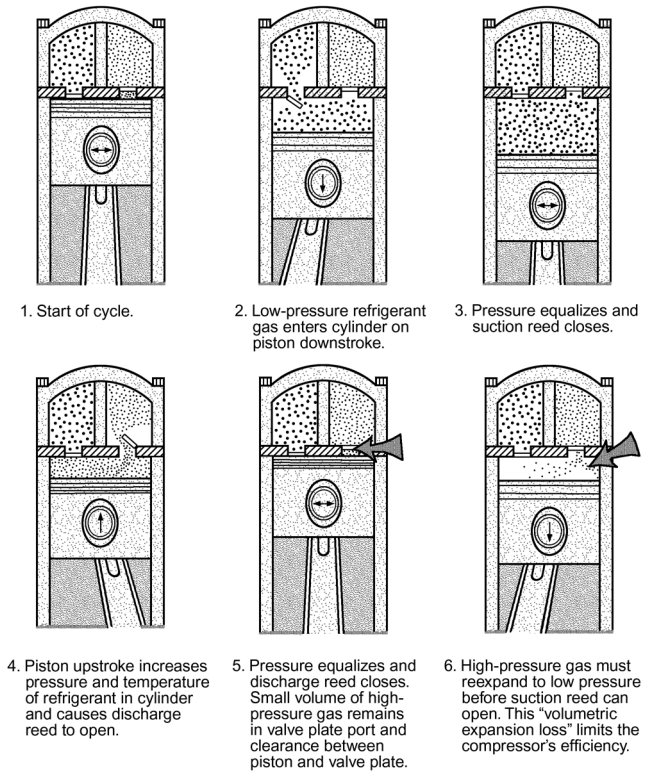


Fig. 7 Pumping Cycle of Reciprocating Compressor

For refrigeration applications, **booster compressors** are typically used for low-temperature applications with R-404A/R-507 or lower-GWP refrigerants R-448A, R449A, R452A, and R-717 (ammonia). Saturated suction below –40°C can be achieved in a booster compressor application.

The booster raises refrigerant pressure to a level where further compression can be achieved with a high-stage compressor, without exceeding the pressure-ratio limits of the respective machines.

Because superheat is generated as a result of compression in the booster, intercooling is often required to reduce the refrigerant temperature to the level required at the inlet to the high-stage unit. Inter-

Table 1 Typical Design Features of Reciprocating Compressors

Item	Refrigerant Type: Halo-, Fluoro-, or Hydrocarbon — Open	Halo-, Fluoro-, or Hydrocarbon — Semi-hermetic	Halo-, Fluoro-, or Hydrocarbon — Welded Hermetic	Ammonia — Open
1. Number of cylinders: one to	16	12	6	16
2. Power range	125 W and up	0.35 to 110 kW	0.12 to 20 kW	7.5 kW and up
3. Cylinder arrangement				
a. Vertical, V or W, radial	X	X		
b. Radial, horizontal opposed			X	
c. Horizontal, vertical V or W		X		X
4. Drive				
a. Electric motor		X	X	
b. Direct drive, (coupling), V belt chain, gear, by electric motor or engine	X			X
5. Lubrication: splash or force feed, flooded	X	X	X	X
6. Suction and discharge valves: ring plate or ring or reed flexing	X	X	X	X
7. Suction and discharge valve arrangement				
a. Suction and discharge valves in head	X	X	X	X
b. Uniflow: suction valves in top of piston, suction gas entering through cylinder walls; discharge valves in head	X			X
8. Cylinder cooling				
a. Suction-gas-cooled	X	X	X	X
b. Water jacket cylinder wall, head, or cylinder wall and head	X			X
c. Air-cooled	X	X	X	X
d. Refrigerant-cooled heads	X			X
9. Cylinder head				
a. Spring-loaded	X	X	X	X
b. Bolted	X	X	X	X
10. Bearings				
a. Sleeve, antifriction	X	X	X	X
b. Tapered roller	X			X
11. Capacity control, if provided: manual or automatic				
a. Suction valve lifting	X	X	X	X
b. Bypass-cylinder heads to suction	X	X	X	X
c. Closing inlet	X	X		X
d. Adjustable clearance	X	X		X
e. Variable-speed	X	X	X	X
12. Materials				
Motor insulations and rubber materials must be compatible with refrigerant and lubricant mixtures; otherwise, no restrictions		X	X	
No copper or brass				X
13. Lubricant return				
a. Crankcase separated from suction manifolds, oil return check valves, equalizers, spinners, foam breakers	X	X		X
b. Crankcase common with suction manifold			X	
14. Synchronous fixed speeds, rpm	250 to 3600	1500 to 3600	1500 to 3600	250 to 1500
15. Pistons				
a. Aluminum or cast iron	X	X	X	X
b. Ringless	X	X	X	X
c. Compression and oil-control rings	X	X	X	X
16. Connecting rod				
Split rod with removable cap or solid eccentric strap	X	X	X	X
17. Mounting				
Internal spring mount		X	X	
External spring mount		X	X	
Rigidly mounted on base	X	X		X

cooling methods include controlled liquid injection into the intermediate stream, mixing-type heat exchangers, and heat exchangers where no fluid mixing occurs.

Integral two-stage compressors achieve low temperatures (–30 to –60°C) using appropriate refrigerants within the frame of a single compressor. Cylinders in the compressor are divided into low and high compression stages so that the combination of volumetric flow and pressure ratios are balanced to achieve booster and high-stage performance effectively. Refrigerant connections between the low and high compression stages allow an interstage gas cooling system to be connected to remove superheat between stages. The intercooling in this case is similar to the methods used for individual high-stage and booster compressors.

Economized cycle vapor can also be injected at the interstage port. Capacity selection and unloading capability of the high- and low-pressure stage compressors must be considered to maintain optimal efficiency of the system, as well as discharge temperature limitations of the high-side compressor.

Refrigeration and heat pump applications with carbon dioxide (R-744) operating at transcritical high-side conditions is a growing application with reciprocating compressors due to CO_2 being both low GWP and a natural refrigerant. These reciprocating compressors are applied as single-stage compressors in transcritical operation, along with two-stage (with economized cycle vapor injection, with interstage cooling, or with both).

Capacity reduction with reciprocating compressors may be achieved by cylinder unloading. Cylinder unloading may be achieved by an internal hot-gas bypass unloader, or via a cylinder suction cut-off unloader. **Hot-gas bypass** recirculates discharge gas back to the suction side of the cylinder. Compressor unloading can be done for a single cylinder, or for a pair of cylinders that share a common cylinder head. **Suction cut-off unloading** has a valve on the suction side of one or more cylinders that closes a port that communicates with the compressor inlet. As with hot gas bypass unloading, suction cut-off unloading is implemented in both a single cylinder in some applications or with a pair of cylinders that

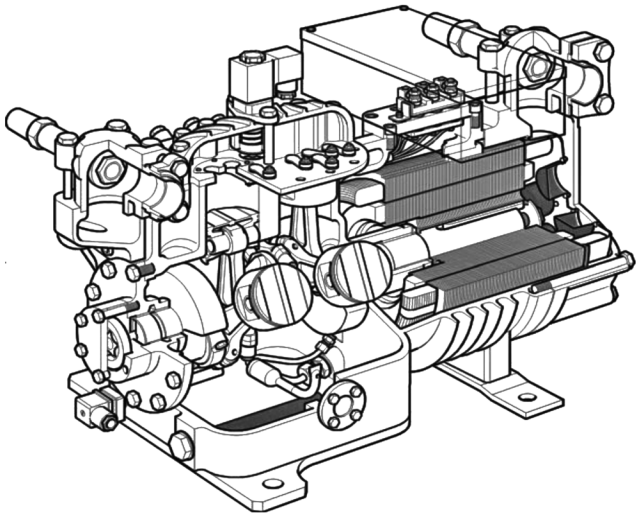


Fig. 8 Six-Cylinder Semi-Hermetic Compressor

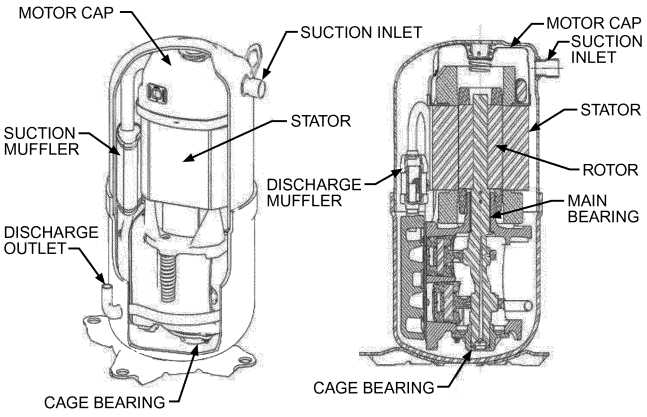


Fig. 9 Hermetic Reciprocating Compressor

share a common suction port. In addition to cylinder unloading, reciprocating compressor capacity modulation is often implemented via pairing the compressor with a variable speed drive. Maximum and minimum allowable speeds are unique to each manufacturer. Maximums are often set to ensure cylinder suction and discharge valve reliability; minimums are frequently set to ensure sufficient journal bearing load capability and reliability. The selection and parameter settings of the variable-speed drive should also be per the compressor or, for open-drive compressors, the motor manufacturer specifications, because not all variable-speed drives can operate the compressor motor throughout the required speed range efficiently and without generating too much heat within the motor.

Performance Data

Figure 10 shows an example set of capacity and power curves for a four-cylinder semi-hermetic compressor, 60.45 mm bore, 44.45 mm stroke, 1740 rpm, operating with R-22. Input conditions for compressor performance are the compressor saturated suction temperature entering the compressor, suction superheat, discharge saturated temperature, and compressor speed. Open-drive compressor speed is specified explicitly, and hermetic/semi-hermetic compressor speed is specified as motor input in hertz (e.g., 50 or 60 Hz) or the variable-speed drive output frequency. Although condenser subcooling or liquid temperature entering the main expansion device does not affect compressor mass flow or power, it is often provided as a reference to convert the compressor mass flow into evaporator capacity. Compressor manufacturers follow ASHRAE *Standard* 23 for testing performed to create rating curves. Compressor rating curves should contain the following information:

- Compressor identification
- Reference degrees of subcooling
- Degrees of superheat
- Compressor speed
- Refrigerant
- Suction gas superheat
- Compressor ambient
- External cooling requirements (if any)

Motor Performance

Motor efficiency is usually a compromise between cost and size. Generally, a physically larger motor for a given power rating will be more efficient. The typical efficiency range for AC induction motors is 85 to 95%. Uneven torque loading can have a marked effect on motor efficiency. It is important that cylinder spacing and unloader design consider torque throughout the revolution of the crankshaft to ensure efficient and reliable motor operation. Also, a higher number of compressor cylinders reduces these impulses. Increasing the moment of inertia of moving parts and increasing speeds reduce the impulse effect, as well. Evenly spaced impulses also help reduce noise and vibration.

Because many compressors are required to start against load, it is desirable to estimate starting torque when selecting a motor for open drive compressors. Equation (11) is an example torque calculation for a single-cylinder compressor. It neglects friction, valve losses, leakage, and the fact that tangential force at the crankpin is not always equal to normal force at the piston. This equation is sufficient for a preliminary estimate.

$$T_s = \frac{(p_2 - p_1)As}{2N_2/N_1} \tag{11}$$

where

T_s = starting torque, N·m
p_2 = discharge pressure, Pa
p_1 = pressure on other side of piston, Pa
A = area of cylinder, m^2
s = stroke of compressor, m
N_2 = motor speed, rev/s
N_1 = compressor speed, rev/s

Equation (11) reveals that when pressures are balanced or almost equal ($p_2 = p_1$), starting torque requirements are considerably reduced. Thus, a system pressure-balancing device on an expansion valve or a capillary tube that equalizes pressures at shutdown allows the compressor to be started without excessive torque. For multicylinder compressors, manufacturers consider the number of cylinders that might be on a compression stroke and the position of the rods at start when specifying motor requirements. Because the force needed to push the piston to the top dead center is a function of how far the rod is from the cylinder centerline, the worst possible angles these might assume can be graphically determined by torque diagrams. Torques for example arrangements are shown in Table 2.

Pull-up torque is an important characteristic of motor starting strength because it represents the lowest torque capability of the motor and typically occurs between 25 and 75% of the operating speed. The motor's pull-up torque must exceed the torque requirement of the compressor or the motor will cease to accelerate and trip the safety overload protection device.

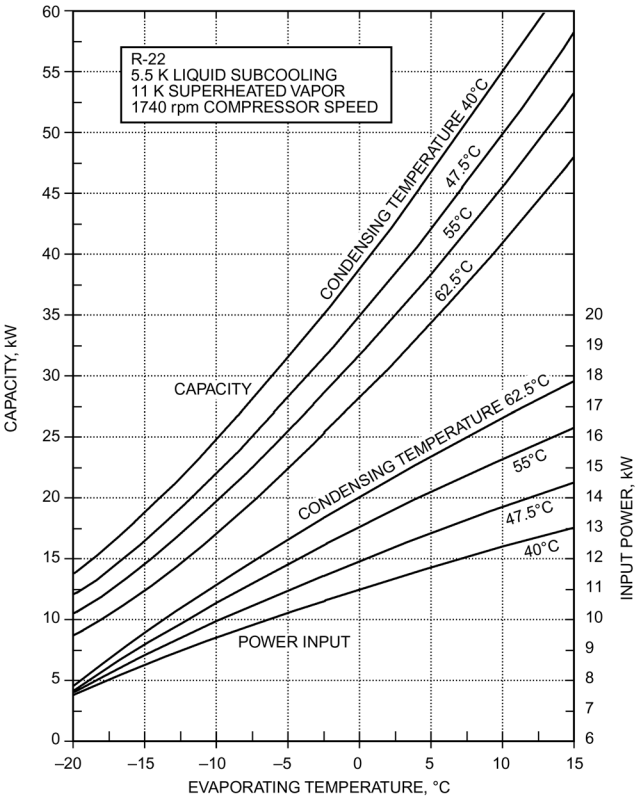


Fig. 10 Capacity and Power-Input Curves for Typical Semi-Hermetic Reciprocating Compressor

Table 2 Motor-Starting Torques

No. Cylinders	Arrangement of Crank Throws	Angle Between Cylinders	Approximate Torque from Equation (11)
1	Single	N/A	T_s
2	Single	90°	$1.025T_s$
2	180° apart	0° or 180°	T_s
3	Single	60°	$1.225T_s$
3	120° apart	120°	T_s
4	180°, 2 rods/crank	90°	$1.025T_s$
6	180°, 3 rods/crank	60°	$1.23T_s$

Features

Crankcases. The compressor crankcase or cylinder block in a welded hermetic compressor is often made of cast iron. Aluminum is also used, particularly in open compressors for transportation refrigeration wheremass is more significant to the application. Open-drive and semi-hermetic crankcases enclose the running gear, oil sump, and, in the latter case, the hermetic motor. Access openings with removable covers may be provided for assembly and service purposes. Welded hermetic compressor cylinder blocks are often just skeletons, consisting of cylinders, main bearings, and either a barrel into which the hermetic motor stator is inserted or a surface to which the stator can be bolted.

Cylinders can be integral with the crankcase or cylinder block, in which case a material that provides a good sealing surface and resists wear must be provided. In aluminum crankcases, cast-in liners of iron or steel are common. In large compressors, premachined cylinder sleeves inserted in the crankcase are typical. With halocarbon refrigerants, excessive cylinder wear or scoring is not often an issue and the choice of integral cylinders or inserted sleeves is frequently based on manufacturing considerations.

Crankshafts. Crankshafts are often forged steel with hardened bearing surfaces finished to 0.20 µm or iron castings. Grade 25 to 40 (170 to 275 MPa) tensile gray iron can be used where the lower modulus of elasticity can be tolerated. Nodular iron shafts approach the stiffness, strength, and ductility of steel and should be polished in both directions of rotation to 0.40 µm maximum for best results. Crankshafts often include counterweights and should be dynamically and/or statically balanced.

A safe maximum stress is important in crankshaft design, but it is equally important to prevent excessive deflection that may edge-load bearings that can result in failure. In hermetic and semi-hermetic compressors, excessive crankshaft deflection can allow the motor air gap to become eccentric, which affects starting, reduces efficiency, produces noise, and further increases bearing edge loading.

Generally, the harder the journal bearing material used within the compressor, the more the shaft hardness requirement increases. With bronze bearings, a journal hardness of 350 Brinell is typical, whereas unhardened shafts at 200 Brinell with babbitt bearings are common. Many combinations of materials and hardnesses have been used successfully.

Main Bearings. Both the crank and drive means may be overhung with bearings in between; however, typical practice places the cylinders between main bearings. Main bearings may be made of steel-backed babbitt, steel-backed or solid bronze, or aluminum. Bearings are usually integral to an aluminum crankcase. Increasingly, metal/polymer bearings with self-lubricating properties are being used. By automotive standards, HVAC&R compressor bearing unit loadings are low to ensure long life. An oil/refrigerant mixture frequently provides only marginal lubrication, but 8000 h/year operation in commercial refrigeration service is possible. For conventional shaft diameters and speeds, 4 MPa main bearing loading based on projected area is not unusual. Typical running clearances are 0.001 mm per millimetre of diameter with steel-backed babbitt bearings and a steel or iron shaft. Bearing oil grooves placed in the unloaded area are common. Feeding oil to the bearing is only one requirement of bearing design; another is venting evolved refrigerant gas and providing the lubricant escape from the bearing to carry away heat.

In most compressors, crankshaft thrust surfaces (with or without thrust washers) must be provided in addition to main bearings. Thrust washers may be steel-backed babbitt, bronze, aluminum, hardened steel, or polymer and are usually stationary. Oil grooves are often included in the thrust face.

Connecting Rods and Eccentric Straps. Connecting rods have the crankshaft end split and a bolted cap for assembly. Unsplit eccentric straps require the crankshaft to be passed through the big bore during assembly. Rods or straps may be made of steel, aluminum, bronze, nodular iron, or gray iron. Steel or iron rods often require inserts of bearing material such as steel-backed babbitt or bronze, whereas aluminum and bronze rods can bear directly on the crankpin and piston pin. Refrigerant compressor service limits unit loading to 20 MPa based on projected area with a bronze bushing in the rod small bore and a hardened steel piston pin. An aluminum rod load at the piston pin of 14 MPa has been used. Large end-unit loads are usually under 7 MPa.

The Scotch yoke type of piston-rod assembly has also been used. In small compressors, it has been fabricated by hydrogen-brazing steel components. Machined aluminum components have been used in large hermetic designs.

Piston, Piston Ring, and Piston Pin. Pistons are typically made of cast iron or aluminum. Cast-iron pistons with a running clearance of 0.4 mm per metre of diameter in the cylinder will seal adequately without piston rings. With aluminum pistons, rings are required

because a running clearance in the cylinder of 2 mm/m or more of diameter is common, with increased potential for leakage. A second or third compression ring may add to power consumption with little increase in capacity; however, it may help oil control, particularly if drained. Oil-scraping rings with vented grooves may also be used. Cylinder finishes are usually obtained by honing, and a 0.3 to 1.0 μm range will give good ring seating. An effective oil scraper can often be obtained with a sharp corner on the piston skirt.

Minimum piston length is determined by the side thrust and is also a function of running clearance. Where clearance is large, longer pistons may be designed to prevent slap. An aluminum piston (with ring) having a length equal to 0.75 times the diameter, with a running clearance of 0.002 mm per millimetre of diameter, and a rod-length-to-crank-arm ratio of 4.5 has been used successfully.

Piston pins are steel, case-hardened to Rockwell C 50 to 60 and ground to a 0.2 μm finish or better. Pins can be restrained against rotation in either the piston bosses or the rod small end, be free in both, or be full-floating, which is common with aluminum pistons and rods. Retaining rings prevent the pin from moving endwise and abrading the cylinder wall.

There is no well-defined limit to piston speed; an average velocity of 6 m/s, determined by multiplying twice the stroke in metres by the revolutions per second, has been used successfully.

Suction and Discharge Valves. These valves are critical components of a reciprocating compressor. Successful designs are reliable and provide high volumetric efficiency and low pressure loss. Improper timing of opening/closing and excessive leakage significantly affect volumetric efficiency. Excessive pressure loss across the valve results from high gas velocities, poor mechanical action, or both.

Suction valves begin to open when the cylinder pressure decreases below suction plenum pressure, and discharge valves begin to open when cylinder pressure increases above discharge plenum pressure. Note that the valve flow area gradually increases during opening, which increases conditions cylinder overpressure pulse with discharge valves and underpressure for suction valves. These pulses significantly affect compressor performance, noise, and vibration. Minimizing this usually leads to better overall compressor performance.

A valve should meet the following requirements:

- Reliability
- Sufficient flow areas with shortest possible movement
- Straight gas flow path, minimum directional changes
- Valve mass and lift should satisfy timing requirements
- Symmetry of design with minimum pressure imbalance
- Minimum clearance volume
- Low cost
- Tight sealing at ports (low leakage)
- Minimum valve flutter

Most valves in use today fall in one of the following groups:

- **Free-floating reed valve**, with backing to limit movement, seats against a flat surface with circular or elongated ports. It is simple, and stresses can be readily determined, but it is limited to relatively small ports; therefore, multiples are often used. Totally backed with a curved stop, it can stand considerable abuse.
- **Reed, clamped at one end**, with full backstop support or a stop at the tip to limit movement, has a more complex motion than a free-floating reed; it may have multiple modes of deformation. Considerable care must be taken in design to ensure reliability.
- **Ring valve** usually has a spring return. A free-floating ring is seldom used because of its high leakage loss. Improved performance is obtained by using spring return, in the form of coil springs or flexing backup springs, with each valve. Ring-type valves are particularly adaptable to compressors using cylinder sleeves.
- **Valve formed as a ring** has part of the valve structure clamped. Generally, full rings are used with one or more sets of slots arranged in circles. By clamping the center, alignment is ensured and a force is obtained that closes the valve. To limit stresses, the valve proportions, valve stops, and supports are designed to control and limit valve motion.

Lubrication. Lubrication systems range from a simple splash system to the elaborate forced-feed systems with filters, vents, and equalizers. The type of lubrication required depends largely on bearing load and application.

For low to medium bearing loads and factory-assembled systems where cleanliness can be controlled, the **splash system** can provide excellent service. Bearing clearances must be larger, however; otherwise, oil does not enter the bearing readily. The dippers' splashing in the oil and the freer bearings increase compressor operation noise. Furthermore, the splash at high speed encourages frothing (foaming) and oil pumping; this is not a problem in packaged equipment but may be in remote systems where gas lines are long. Foaming can also help reduce compressor noise, and sometimes foaming agents can be added to the oil for this purpose.

Lubrication for a **flooded system** includes disks, screws, grooves, oil-ring gears, or other devices that lift the oil to the shaft or bearing level. These devices flood the bearing and are not much better than splash systems, except that the oil is not agitated as violently, so operation is quieter. Because little or no pressure is developed by this method, it is not considered forced-feed.

In **forced-feed lubrication**, a pump gear, vane, or plunger develops pressure, which forces oil into the bearing. Smaller bearing clearances can be used with higher load-carrying capability because adequate pressure feeds oil in sufficient quantity for proper bearing cooling. As a result, compressor operation may be quieter.

Gear pumps are common. Spur gears are simple but tend to promote flashing of refrigerant dissolved in the oil because of the sudden opening of the tooth volume as two teeth disengage. This disadvantage is not apparent in internal eccentric gear or vane pumps where the suction volume gradually opens. Thus, eccentric gear, vane, or piston pumps give better performance than simple gear pumps when the pump is not submerged in the oil.

Oil pumps must be made with proper clearances to pump a mixture of gas and oil. The pump discharge should have provision to bleed a small quantity of oil into the crankcase. A bleed vents the pumps, prevents excess pressure, and ensures faster priming.

A strainer should be inserted in the suction line to keep foreign substances from the pump and bearings. If large quantities of fine particles are present and bearing load is high, it may be necessary to add an oil filter to the discharge side of the pump.

Oil must return from suction gas into the compressor crankcase. A flow of gas from piston leakage opposes this oil flow, so leakage gas velocity must be low to permit oil to separate from the gas. A separating chamber may be built as part of the compressor to help separate oil from the gas.

In many designs, a check valve is inserted at the bottom of the oil return port to prevent a surge of crankcase oil from entering the suction. This check valve must have a bypass, which is always open, to allow the check valve to open wide after the oil surge has passed. When a separating chamber is used, the oil surge is trapped before it can enter the suction port, thus making a check valve less essential.

Seals. Stationary and rotary seals have been used extensively on open reciprocating compressors. Older stationary seals usually used metallic bellows and a hardened shaft for a wearing surface. Their use has diminished because of high cost.

The rotary seal costs less and is more reliable. A synthetic seal tightly fitted to the shaft prevents leakage and seals against the back face of the stationary member of the seal. The front face of this carbon nose seals against a stationary cover plate. This design has been used on shafts up to 100 mm in diameter. The rotary seal should be

designed so that the carbon nose is never subjected to the full thrust of the shaft, the spring should be designed for minimum cocking force, and materials should be selected to minimize swelling and shrinking.

Special Devices

Capacity Control. Capacity control may be obtained by (1) controlling suction pressure by throttling, (2) controlling discharge pressure, (3) bypassing discharge gas to suction, (4) adding reexpansion volume to reduce volumetric efficiency, (5) changing the stroke, (6) opening a cylinder discharge port to suction while closing the port to discharge manifold, (7) changing compressor speed, (8) closing off cylinder inlet, and (9) holding the suction valve open.

The most commonly used methods are opening the suction valves by some external force (9), gas bypassing within the compressor (6), suction shutoff, gas bypassing outside the compressor (3), and variable speed (7).

When capacity control compressors are used, system design becomes more important, and the following must be considered:

- Possible increase in compressor vibration (lower capacity), discharge gas pulsations, and sound level (higher capacity)
- Minimum operating conditions as limited by discharge or motor temperatures (or both) at part-load conditions
- Good oil return at lowest capacity
- Rapid cycling of unloaders
- Refrigerant metering device (TXV or capillary tube) capable of controlling at minimum capacity

Crankcase Heaters. When refrigerant might accumulate in the compressor crankcase (cold start, gravitation, etc.) and dilute the oil excessively, resulting in flooded starts, a crankcase heater should be used. The heater should maintain the oil at least 10 K above the rest of the system at shutdown and well below the breakdown temperature of the oil at any time.

Internal Centrifugal Separators. Some compressors are equipped with antislug devices in the gas path to the cylinders. This device centrifugally separates oil and liquid refrigerant from the flow of foam during a flooded start and thus protects the cylinders. It does not eliminate other hazards caused by liquid refrigerant in gas compressors.

Automatic Oil Separators. Oil separators are used most often to reduce the amount of oil discharged into the system by the compressor and to return oil to the crankcase. They are recommended for all field-erected systems and on packaged equipment where lubricant contamination has a negative effect on evaporator capacity and/or where lubricant return at reduced capacity is marginal.

Application

Parallel Operation. Where multiple compressors are used, the trend is toward completely independent refrigerant circuits. This has an obvious advantage in the case of hermetic motor burnout and with lubricant equalization.

Parallel operation of compressors in a single system has some operational advantage at part load. The inherent higher system efficiency when operating only one compressor is a desirable advantage. The displacement of each compressor can also be varied to provide even more capacity control options.

Careful attention must be given to apportioning returned oil to the multiple compressors so that each always has an adequate quantity. Figure 11 shows the method most widely used. Line A connects the tops of the crankcases and tends to equalize pressure above the oil; line B permits oil equalization at the normal level. Lines of generous diameter must be used. Generally, line A is a large diameter, and line B is a small diameter, which limits possible blowing of oil from one crankcase to the other.

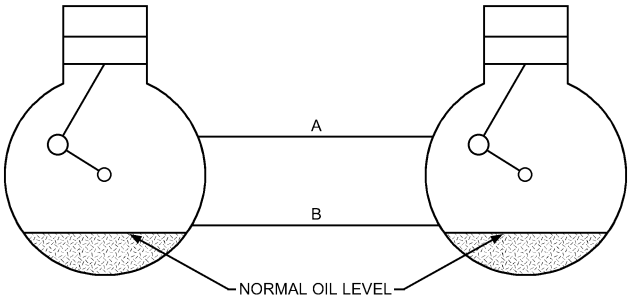


Fig. 11 Modified Oil-Equalizing System

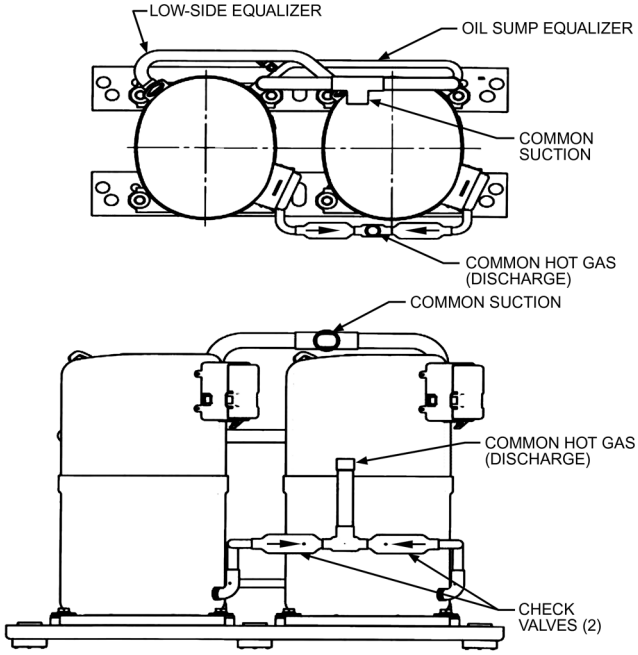


Fig. 12 Tandem Compressors

A central reservoir for returned oil may also be used with means (such as crankcase float valves) for maintaining the proper levels in the various compressors. With staged systems, the low-stage compressor oil pump can sometimes deliver a measured amount of oil to the high-stage crankcase. The high-stage oil return is then sized and located to return a slightly greater quantity of oil to the low-stage crankcase. Where compressors are at different elevations and/or staged, pumps in each oil line are necessary to maintain adequate crankcase oil level. In both cases, proper gas equalization must be provided.

When fitted with check valves as noted in Figure 12, the compressors may be staged on to reduce power inrush, and/or each compressor can operate independently to provide refrigeration capacity modulation. For vibration control and optimum interconnecting tubing life, the compressors are usually hard mounted to a set of rails as shown, and the assembly is then isolated from the system base pan using rubber mounting grommets.

Operation at Low Suction Pressure. Because reciprocating compressors do not rely on refrigerant flow to deliver oil and cool surfaces with boundary lubrication, they are uniquely suitable for low-suction-pressure applications, such as medium- and low-temperature refrigeration. Efficiency of these compressors is lower than more advanced designs, but reliability is extremely high.

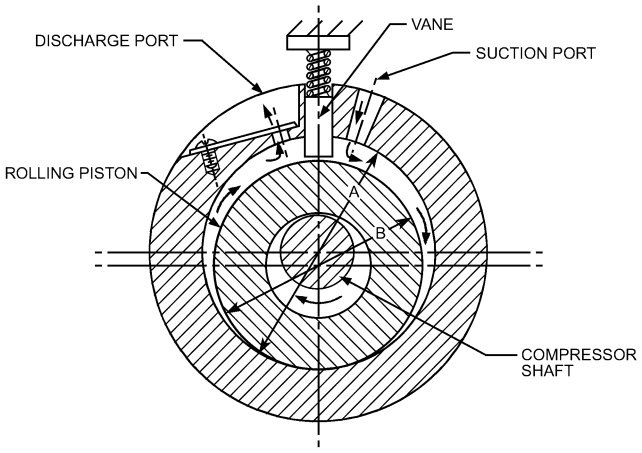


Fig. 13 Fixed-Vane, Rolling-Piston Rotary Compressor

3. ROTARY COMPRESSORS

3.1 ROLLING-PISTON COMPRESSORS

Rolling-piston, or fixed-vane, rotary compressors are used in air-conditioning units in capacities up to about 9 kW and refrigerators up to 2 kW (Figure 13). This type of compressor uses a roller mounted on the eccentric of a shaft with a single vane or blade suitably positioned in the nonrotating cylindrical housing, generally called the cylinder block. The blade reciprocates in a slot machined in the cylinder block. This reciprocating motion is caused by the eccentrically moving roller.

Geometrical displacement for this compressor can be calculated from

$$V_d = \pi H(D^2 - d^2)/4 \quad (12)$$

where

V_d = displacement
H = cylinder block height
D = cylinder diameter
d = roller diameter

The drive motor stator and compressor are solidly mounted in the compressor housing. This design feature can lead to significant torsional vibration, and special measures should be implemented to avoid damage to suction and discharge tubes. A discharge tube attached to the compressor should be in the form of a C coil. If a suction accumulator is used, it must be attached to the compressor shell by supporting brackets of sufficient strength. Special grommets should be used to avoid transmitting the vibration to the compressor support. Using flexible suction and discharge tubes can significantly reduce vibration transmission and noise.

Because the amplitude of torsional vibration increases at lower compressor speed, it may be a problem to operate a single-cylinder rotary compressor below 1800rpm. Twin-cylinder rotary compressors with eccentrics on the same shaft in opposite directions can produce less torsional vibration and are suitable to operate at as low as 600 rpm.

Rotary types are usually high-side compressors. Suction gas is piped directly into the suction port of the compressor, and compressed gas is discharged into the compressor housing shell. This high-side shell design is used because, in this case, the vane does not require a strong spring (after discharge pressure is built up, it creates enough force to maintain engagement between the roller and vane without the spring force) and lubrication of the vane in the slot is ensured by the pressure differential between the oil sump (high pressure) and suction chamber.

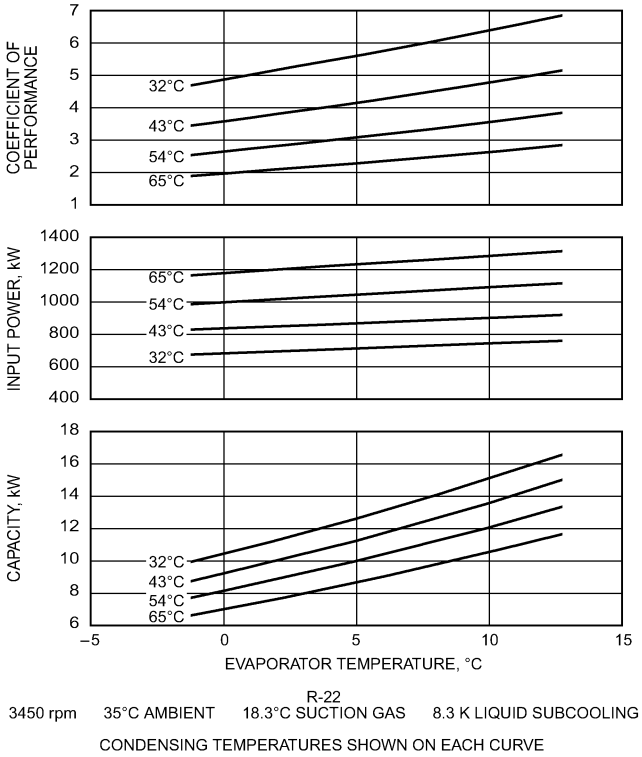


Fig. 14 Performance Curves for Typical Rolling-Piston Compressor

To avoid significant discharge pulsations inside the shell and the consequent high noise level, a special discharge muffler is installed to cover the discharge valve. Discharge mufflers can be made from different materials, including plastics.

Maintaining the proper oil level in rotary compressors is extremely important. The oil level should be high enough to cover the vane, providing adequate lubrication and leakage reduction, but not higher than the discharge port, because excessive oil will be pushed out of the compressor by discharge gas and may contaminate the heat exchangers. In some designs, the electrical rotor is used as an oil separator (special blades are installed on the rotor top), or a special plate is installed to shield the discharge tube entry and force separation of refrigerant and oil by inertia.

Internal leakage is controlled through hydrodynamic sealing and selection of mating parts for optimum clearance. Hydrodynamic sealing depends on clearance, surface speed, surface finish, and oil viscosity. Close tolerance and low-surface-finish machining is necessary to support hydrodynamic sealing and to reduce gas leakage.

Performance

Rotary compressors have a high volumetric efficiency because of the small clearance volume and correspondingly low reexpansion losses inherent in their design. Figure 14 and Table 3 show performance of a typical rolling-piston rotary compressor, commercially available for room air conditioning and small, packaged heat pump applications.

An acceptable sound level is important in the design of any small compressor. Figure 15 shows the influence of a compressor on home refrigerator noise. Because gas flow is continuous and no suc-

Table 3 Typical Rolling-Piston Compressor Performance

Compressor speed	3450 rpm
Refrigerant	R-22
Condensing temperature	55°C
Liquid refrigerant temperature	46°C
Evaporator temperature	7°C
Suction pressure	625 kPa
Suction gas temperature	18°C
Evaporator capacity	3.5 kW
Coefficient of performance	3.22
Input power	1090 W

tion valve is required, rotary compressors can be relatively quiet. The sound spectrum (sound signature) of the rotary compressors is quite distinctive. At 3600 rpm, sound level elevation between 600 and 900 Hz can be explained by gas flow and pulsations, from 1500 to 2500 Hz by valve impact, and above 3500 Hz mostly by friction.

Features

Shafts and Journals. Shaft deflection under load is caused by compression gas loading of the roller and the torsional and side-pull loading of the motor rotor. Design criteria must require minimum oil film under the maximum run and starting loads. The motor rotor should have minimal deflection, to eliminate starting problems under extreme conditions of torque; the air gap between rotor and stator should be maintained as constant as possible around the circumference.

Shafts are generally made from steel forging and ductile iron. Journals are ground round to high precision and polished to a finish of 0.25 µm or better. The lower portion of the shaft (eccentric and lower journals) is hollow and serves as an oil pump using centrifugal force to deliver oil to the thrust surfaces and journals through labyrinth holes. Vertical or angular grooves are made in the journals or bearings, to aid in distribution of the oil.

Bearings. The bearing must support the rotating member under all conditions. Powdered metal has been extensively used for these components, because its porous properties help in lubrication. This material can also be formed into complex bearing shapes with little machining required. Cast iron is also widely used, especially for the lower bearing.

Vanes. Vanes are designed for reliability by the choice of materials and lubrication. The vanes are hardened, ground, and polished to the best finish obtainable. Steel, powdered metal, and aluminum alloys have been used; however, the best results are achieved by using M2 tool steel. Special coatings and excessive hardness (above 70 Rockwell C) have not shown meaningful improvement in reliability or long-term performance. Aluminum is impractical because of its significant difference from iron in thermal expansion, which requires higher clearance between the vane and vane slot and, consequently, leads to higher leakage and inconsistent lubrication.

The vane tip radius should be selected to minimize Hertz stresses between the roller and the vane, but the sharp edge of the vane should never be in contact with the roller.

Vane Springs. Vane springs force the vane to stay in contact with the roller during start-up. The spring rate depends on the inertia of the vane. Two types of springs are widely used: C-type and helicoil.

Valves. Only discharge valves are required by rolling-piston rotary compressors. They are usually simple reed valves made of high-grade steel. Proper design of the valve stop is important for valve reliability and noise reduction.

Lubrication. A properly designed lubrication system circulates an ample supply of clean oil to all working surfaces, bearings, vanes, vane slots, and seal faces. High-side pressure in the housing shell ensures a sufficient pressure differential across the passageways that distribute oil to the bearing surfaces.

Mechanical Efficiency. High mechanical efficiency depends on

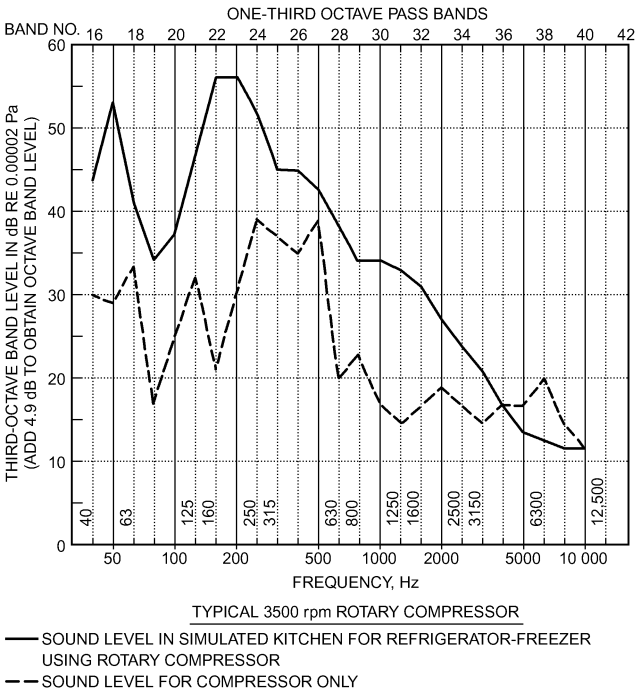


Fig. 15 Sound Level of Combination Refrigerator-Freezer with Typical Rotary Compressor

between the vane and slot wall, vane tip, and roller wall, and roller and bearing faces. The amount and distribution of these losses vary based on the geometry of the compressor.

Motor Selection. Breakdown torque requirements depend on the displacement of the compressor, the refrigerant, and the operating range. Domestic refrigerator compressors typically require a breakdown torque of about 190 to 200 N·m per litre of compressor displacement per revolution. Similarly, larger compressors using R-22 for window air conditioners require about 350 to 360 N·m breakdown torque per litre of compressor displacement per revolution.

Rotary machines do not usually require complete unloading for successful starting. Pressure differentials up to 100 kPa can be tolerated. The starting torque of standard split-phase motors is ample for small compressors. Permanent split-capacitor motors for air conditioners of various sizes provide sufficient starting and improve the power factor to the required range.

3.2 ROTARY-VANE COMPRESSORS

Rotary-vane compressors have a low mass-to-displacement ratio, which, in combination with compact size, makes them suitable for transport application. Small compressors in the 2 to 40 kW range are single-staged for a saturated suction temperature range of –25 to 15°C at saturated condensing temperatures up to 75°C. Currently, R-22, R-134a, R-404A, R-407, R-410A, R-507, and R-717 are the refrigerants used for these compressor applications.

Figure 16 is a cross-sectional view of an eight-bladed compressor. The eight discrete volumes are referred to as cells. A single shaft rotation produces eight distinct compression strokes. Although conventional valves are not required for this compressor, suction and discharge check valves are recommended to prevent reverse rotation and oil logging during shutdown.

The design of the compressor results in a fixed, built-in compression ratio. Compression ratio is determined by the relationship

between the volume of the cell as it is closed off from the suction port to its volume before it opens to the discharge port.

The compressors currently available are of an oil-flooded, open-drive design, which requires an oil separator. Single-stage separators are used in close-coupled systems with high saturation suction temperature (SST), where oil return is not a problem. Two-stage separators with a coalescing second stage are used in low-SST systems, in ammonia systems, and in flooded evaporators likely to trap oil.

Rotary-vane compressors are more complicated (more parts) and consequently more expensive than rolling-piston or scroll compressors, and their efficiency is comparatively low. Therefore, many of these compressors are being replaced with more advanced scroll or rotary types. However, the reliability of well-established rotary-vane designs is on par with other types.

3.3 SCREW COMPRESSORS

Screw compressors for refrigeration and air-conditioning applications are of two distinct types: single-screw and twin-screw. Both are conventionally used with fluid injection where sufficient fluid cools and seals the compressor. Screw compressors can operate at pressure ratios above 20:1 single stage.

Single-Screw Compressors

Description. A single-screw compressor consists of a single cylindrical main rotor that works with one or a pair of gate rotors. Both the main rotor and gate rotor(s) can vary widely in terms of form and mutual geometry. Figure 17 shows the design normally encountered in refrigeration.

The main rotor has helical grooves, with a cylindrical periphery and a globoid (or hourglass) root profile. The two identical gate rotors are located on opposite sides of the main rotor. The casing enclosing the main rotor has two slots, which allow the teeth of the gate rotors to pass through them.

The compressor is driven through the main rotor shaft, and the gate rotors follow by direct meshing action with the main rotor. The geometry of the single-screw compressor is such that gas compression power is transferred directly from the main rotor to the gas. No power (other than small frictional losses) is transferred across the meshing points to the gate rotors.

Compression Process. The operation of the single-screw compressor can be divided into three distinct phases: suction, compression, and discharge. The process is shown in Figure 18.

Mechanical Features.

Rotors. The screw rotor is normally made of cast or ductile iron, and the mating gate rotors are made from an engineered plastic. The inherent lubricating quality of the plastic and its compliant nature allow the single-screw compressor to achieve close clearances with conventional manufacturing practice.

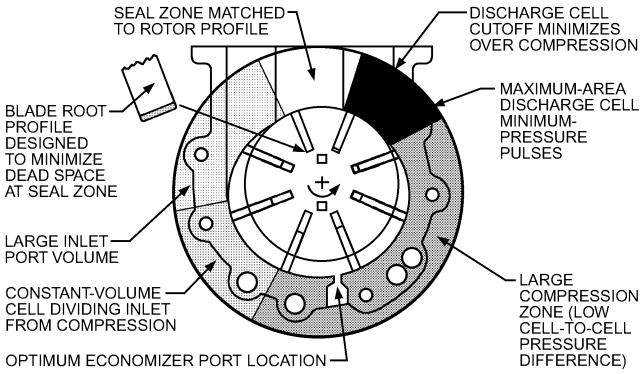


Fig. 16 Rotary-Vane Compressor

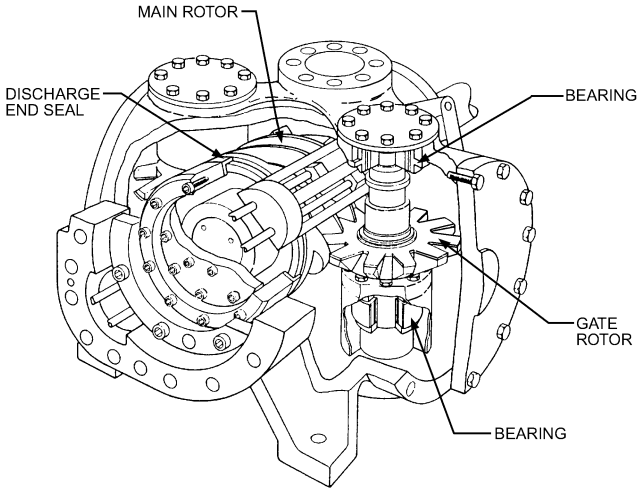
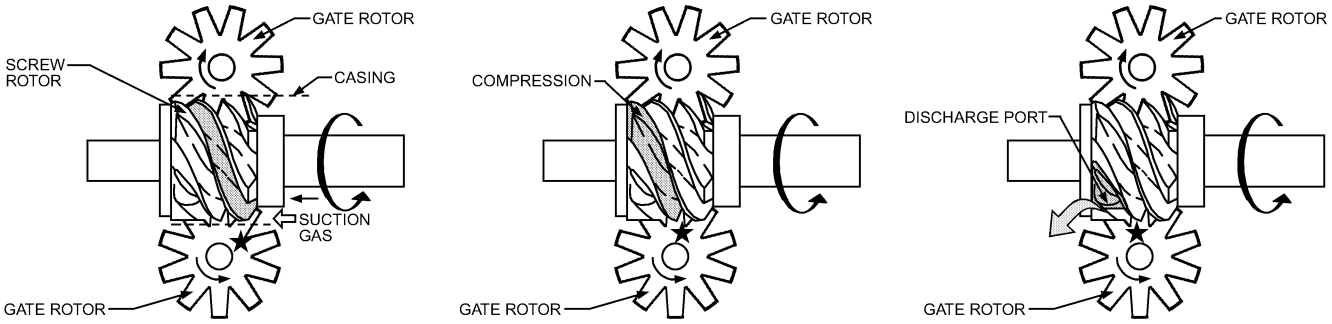


Fig. 17 Section of Single-Screw Refrigeration Compressor



Suction. During rotation of the main rotor, a typical groove in open communication with the suction chamber gradually fills with suction gas. The tooth of the gate rotor in mesh with the groove acts as an aspirating piston.

Compression. As the main rotor turns, the groove engages a tooth on the gate rotor and is covered simultaneously by the cylindrical main rotor casing. The gas is trapped in the space formed by the three sides of the groove, the casing, and the gate rotor tooth. As rotation continues, the groove volume decreases and compression occurs.

Discharge. At the geometrically fixed point where the leading edge of the groove and the edge of the discharge port coincide, compression ceases, and the gas discharges into the delivery line until the groove volume has been reduced to zero.

Fig. 18 Sequence of Compression Process in Single-Screw Compressor

The gate rotors are mounted on a metal support designed to carry the differential pressure between discharge pressure and suction pressure. The gate rotor function is equivalent to that of a piston in that it sweeps the groove and causes compression to occur. Furthermore, the gate rotor is in direct contact with the screw groove flanks and thus also acts as a seal. Each gate rotor is attached to its support by a simple spring and dashpot mechanism, allowing the gate rotor, with a low moment of inertia, to have an angular degree of freedom from the larger mass of the support. This method of attachment allows the gate rotor assemblies to pass a significant amount of liquid slug during transient operation without damage or wear.

Bearings. In a typical open or semi-hermetic single-screw compressor, the main rotor shaft contains one pair of angular contact ball bearings (an additional angular contact or roller bearing is used for some heat pump semi-hermetic compressors). On the opposite side of the screw, one roller bearing is used.

Note that compression takes place simultaneously on each side of the main rotor of the single-screw compressor. This balanced gas pressure results in virtually no load on the rotor bearing during full load and while symmetrically unloaded as shown in Figure 19. Should the compressor be unloaded asymmetrically (see economizer operation below 50% capacity), the designer is not restricted by the rotor geometry and can easily add bearings with a long design life to handle the load. Axial loads are also low because the grooves terminate on the outer cylindrical surface of the rotor and suction pressure is vented to both ends of the rotor (Figure 19).

The gate rotor bearing must overcome a small moment force caused by the gas acting on the compression surface of the gate rotor. Each gate rotor shaft has at least one bearing for axial positioning (usually a single angular contact ball bearing can perform the axial positioning and carry the small radial load at one end), and one roller or needle bearing at the other end of the support shaft also carries the radial load.

Cooling, Sealing, and Bearing Lubrication. A major function of injecting a fluid into the compression area is removing heat of compression. Also, because a single-screw compressor has fixed leakage areas, the fluid helps seal leakage paths. Fluid is normally injected into a closed groove through ports in the casing or in the moving capacity control slide. Most single-screw compressors can use many different injection fluids, oil being the most common, to suit the nature of the gas being compressed.

Oil-Injected Compressors. Oil is used in single-screw compressors to seal, cool, lubricate, and actuate capacity control. It gives a flat efficiency curve over a wide compression ratio and speed range, thus decreasing discharge temperature and noise.

Oil-injected single-screw compressors operate at high pressures using common high-pressure refrigerants such as R-22, R-134a, and R-717. They also operate effectively at high pressure ratios because the injected oil cools the compression process.

Oil injection requires an oil separator to remove the oil from the high-pressure refrigerant (Figure 20). For applications with exacting demands for low oil carryover, separation equipment is available to leave less than 5 mg/kg oil in the circulated refrigerant.

With most compressors, oil can be injected automatically without a pump because of the pressure difference between the oil reservoir (discharge pressure) and the reduced pressure in a flute or bearing assembly during compression. However, this injection should be done after the compression chamber is closed (to avoid capacity loss) but before the pressure is higher than discharge (in case of overcompression), which may be very difficult to design. To avoid this limitation, some compressors use a continuously running oil pump to generate oil pressure 200 to 300 kPa over compressor discharge pressure. This pump requires 0.3 to 1.0% of the compressor's motor power.

External oil cooling between the oil reservoir and the point of injection is possible. Various heat exchangers are available to cool the oil: (1) separate water supply, (2) chiller water on a packaged unit, (3) condenser water on a packaged unit, (4) water from an evaporative condenser sump, (5) forced air-cooled oil cooler, and (6) high-pressure liquid recirculation (thermosiphon). Heat added to the oil during compression is the amount usually removed in the oil cooler.

Oil-Injection-Free Compressors. Although single-screw compressors operate well with oil injection, they also operate with good efficiency in an oil-injection-free (OIF) mode with many common halocarbon refrigerants. This means that fluid injected into the compression chamber is the condensate of the fluid being compressed. For air conditioning and refrigeration, where pressure ratios are in the range of 2 to 8, the oil normally injected into the casing may be replaced by liquid refrigerant. Not much lubrication is required because the only power transmitted from the screw to the gate rotors is that needed to overcome small frictional losses. Thus, the refrigerant need only cool and seal the compressor. The liquid refrigerant may still contain a small amount of oil to lubricate the bearings (0.1 to 1%, or higher, depending on compressor design). A typical OIF circuit is depicted in Figure 21.

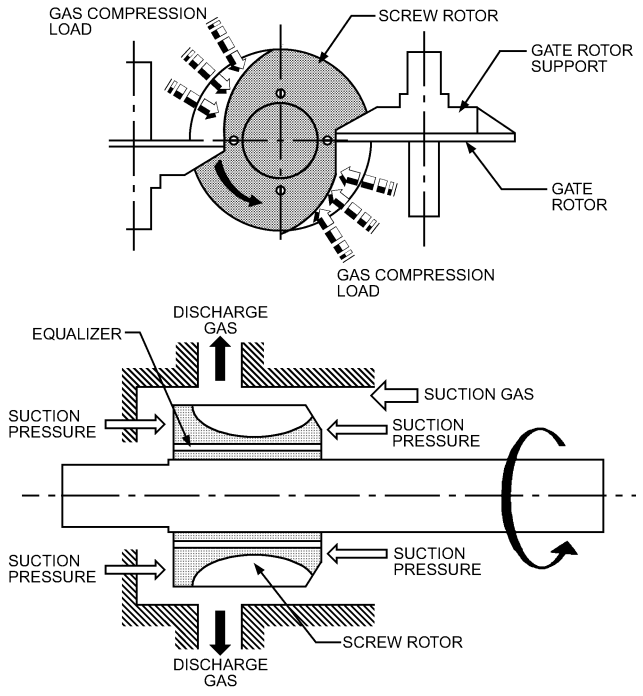


Fig. 19 Radial and Axially Balanced Main Rotor

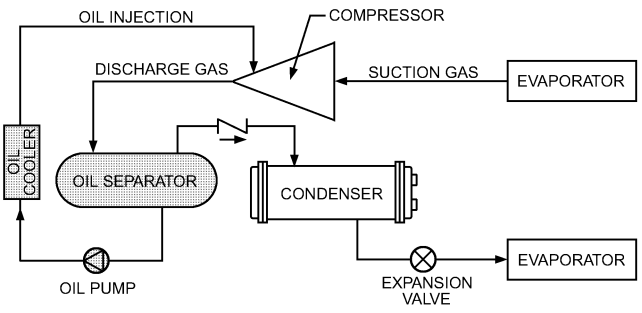


Fig. 20 Oil and Refrigerant Schematic of Oil Injection

This method is used when an oil separator is not available. In this case, the liquid refrigerant carries a significant amount of oil with it. The methods of refrigerant injection include the following:

- **Direct injection of liquid refrigerant** into the compression process. Injection is controlled directly from the compressor discharge temperature, and loss of compressor capacity is minimized as injection takes place in a closed flute just before discharge occurs. This method requires very little power (typically less than 5% of compressor power).
- A **small refrigerant pump** draws liquid from the receiver and injects it directly into the compressor discharge line. The injection rate is controlled by sensing discharge temperature and modulating the pump motor speed. The power penalty in this method is the pump power (about 0.8 kW for compressors up to 750 kW), which can result in energy savings over refrigerant injected into the compression chamber.

Oil-injection-free operation has the following advantages:

- It requires no discharge oil separator, unless an oil separator is needed to reduce the oil circulation rate in the system.
- Compressors require no oil or refrigerant pumps.
- External coolers are not required.

Economizers. Screw compressors are available with a secondary suction port between the primary compressor suction and discharge port. This port, when used with an economizer, provides the means to increase compressor capacity efficiency.

In operation, gas is drawn into the rotor grooves in the normal way from the suction line. The grooves are then sealed off in sequence, and compression begins. An additional charge is added to the closed flute through a suitably placed port in the casing by an intermediate gas source at a slightly higher pressure than that reached in the compression process at that time. The original and additional charges are then compressed together to discharge conditions. The compressor's pumping capacity at suction conditions is not even slightly affected by this additional flow through the economizer port.

When the port is used with an economizer, the effective refrigerating capacity of the economized compressor is increased over the noneconomized compressor by the increased heat absorption capability of the liquid entering the evaporator. Furthermore, the only additional mass flow the compressor must handle is flash gas entering a closed flute, which is above suction pressure. Thus, under most conditions, the capacity improvement also improves efficiency. Economizers become effective when the pressure ratio is 3.5 and above.

Figure 22 shows a pressure-enthalpy diagram for a flash tank economizer. In it, high-pressure liquid passes through an expansion device and enters a tank at an intermediate pressure between suction and discharge. This pressure is maintained by pressure in the compressor's closed flute (closed from suction). Gas generated from the expansion enters the compressor through the economizer port. When passed to the evaporator, the liquid (which is now saturated at the intermediate pressure) gives a larger refrigeration capacity per kilogram. In addition, the percentage increase in power input is lower than the percentage capacity increase.

As a screw compressor is unloaded, economizer pressure falls toward suction pressure. As a result, the additional capacity and improved efficiency of the economizer fall to zero at 70 to 80% of full-load capacity.

The single-screw compressor has two compression chambers, each with its own slide valve. Each slide valve can be operated independently, which allows economizer gas to be introduced into one side of the compressor. By operating the slide independently, the chamber without the economizer gas can be unloaded to 0% capacity (50% capacity of the compressor). The other chamber remains at full capacity and retains the full economizer effect, making the economizer effective below 50% compressor capacity.

The secondary suction port may also be used for (1) a system-side load or (2) a second evaporator that operates at a temperature above that of the primary evaporator.

Some single-screw compressor designs use a patented **centrifugal economizer** that replaces the force of gravity in a flash economizer with centrifugal force to separate flash gas generated at an intermediate pressure from liquid refrigerant before liquid enters the evaporator. The centrifugal economizer thereby uses a much smaller pressure vessel and, in some designs, the economizer fits within the envelope of a standard motor housing without having to increase its size.

Separation is achieved by a centrifugal impeller mounted on the compressor shaft (see Figure 30); a special valve maintains a uniformly thick liquid ring around the circumference of the impeller, ensuring that no gas leaves with the liquid going to the evaporator. Flash gas is then ducted to closed grooves in the compressor screws. Some designs use flash gas with a similar liquid refrigerant to cool the motor before the gas enters the closed compression groove.

Volume (Compression) Ratio. The degree of compression in the rotor grooves is predetermined for a particular port configuration on screw compressors having fixed suction and discharge ports. A characteristic of the compressor is the volume (compression) ratio V_i, which is defined as the ratio of the volume of the groove at the start of compression to the volume of the same groove when it first begins to open to the discharge port. Hence, the volume ratio is determined by the size and shape of the discharge port.

For maximum efficiency, pressure generated within the grooves during compression should exactly equal the pressure in the discharge line at the moment when the groove opens to it. If this is not the case, either over- or undercompression occurs, both resulting in internal losses. Such losses increase power consumption and noise and reduce efficiency.

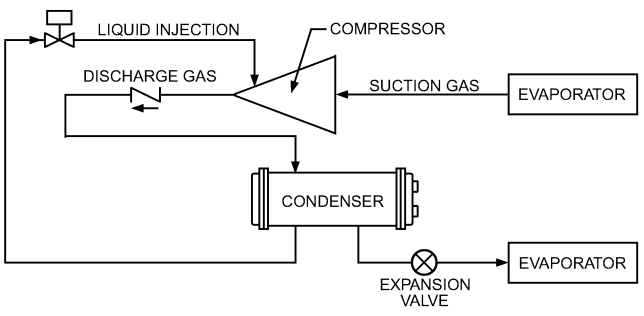


Fig. 21 Schematic of Oil-Injection-Free Circuit

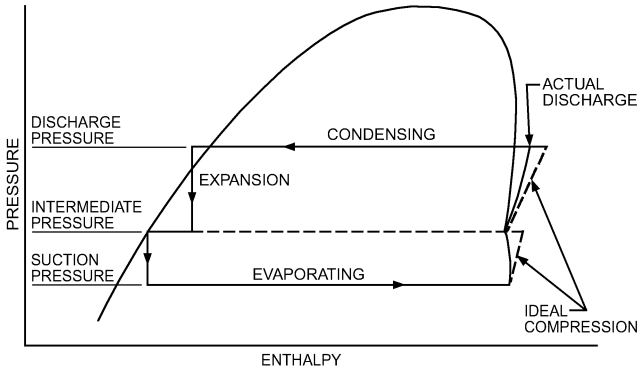


Fig. 22 Theoretical Economizer Cycle

Volume ratio selection should be made according to operating conditions.

Compressors equipped with slide valves (for capacity modulation) usually locate the discharge port at the discharge end of the slide valve. Alternative port configurations yielding the required volume ratios are then designed into the capacity control components, thus providing easy interchangeability both during construction and after installation (although partial disassembly is required).

Single-screw compressors in refrigeration and process applications are equipped with a simple slide valve to vary compressor volume ratio while the compressor is running. The slide valve advances or delays the discharge port opening (Figure 23). Note that a separate slide has been designed to modulate capacity independently of the volume ratio slide (see Figures 24 to 26). Having independent modulation of volume ratio (through discharge port control) and capacity modulation (through a completely independent slide that only varies the position where compression begins) allows the single-screw compressor to achieve efficient volume ratio control when capacity is less than full load.

Capacity Control. As with all positive-displacement compressors, both speed modulation and suction throttling can be used. Ideal capacity modulation for any compressor includes (1) continuous modulation from 100% to less than 10%, (2) good part-load efficiency, (3) unloaded starting, and (4) unchanged reliability.

Variable compressor displacement, the most common means for meeting these criteria, usually takes the form of two movable slide valves in the compressor casing (the single-screw compressor has two gate rotors forming two compression areas). At part load, each slide valve produces a slot that delays the point at which compression begins. This reduces groove volume, and hence compressor throughput. Because suction volume is displaced before compression takes place, little or no thermodynamic loss occurs. However, if no other steps were taken, this mechanism would result in an undesirable drop in the effective volume ratio, in undercompression, and inefficient part-load operation.

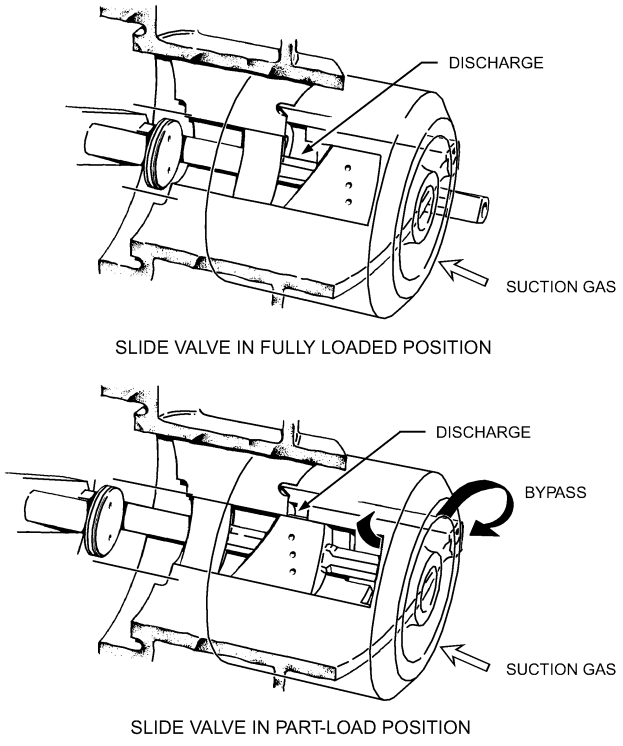


Fig. 23 Capacity-Control Slide Valve Operation

This problem is avoided either by arranging that the capacity modulation valve reduces the discharge port area as the bypass slot is created (Figure 23) or having one valve control capacity only and a second valve independently modulate volume ratio (Figures 24 to 26). A full modulating mechanism is provided in most large single-screw compressors, whereas two-position slide valves are used where requirements allow. The specific part-load performance is affected by a compressor's built-in volume (compression) ratio, evaporator temperature, and condenser temperature, and whether the slide valves are symmetrically or asymmetrically controlled.

Detailed design of the valve mechanism differs between makes of compressors but usually consists of an axial sliding valve along each side of the rotor casing (Figure 23). This mechanism is usually operated by a hydraulic or gas piston and cylinder assembly in the compressor itself or by a positioning motor. The piston is actuated by oil, discharge gas, or high-pressure liquid refrigerant at discharge pressure driven in either direction according to the operation of a four-way solenoid valve.

Figure 25 shows a capacity slide valve (top) and a variable-volume-ratio slide (bottom). The capacity slide is in the full-load position, and the volume ratio slide is at a moderate volume ratio. Figure 26 depicts the same system as shown in Figure 25, except that the capacity slide is in a partially loaded position, and the volume ratio slide has moved to a position to match the new conditions.

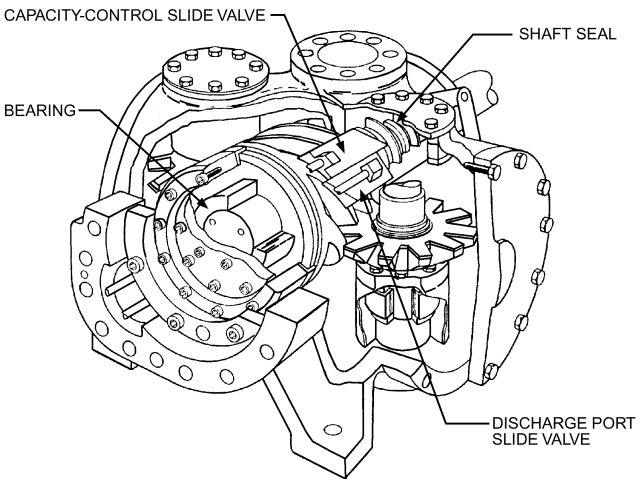


Fig. 24 Refrigeration Compressor Equipped with Variable-Capacity Slide Valve and Variable-Volume-Ratio Slide Valve

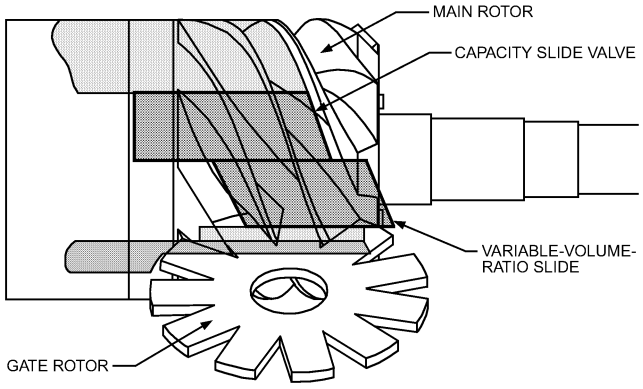


Fig. 25 Capacity Slide in Full-Load Position and Volume Ratio Slide in Intermediate Position

The single-screw compressor's two compression chambers, each with its own capacity slide valve that can be operated independently, permits one slide valve to be unloaded to 0% capacity (50% compressor capacity) while the other slide valve remains at full capacity. This asymmetrical operation improves part-load efficiency below 50% capacity, and further part-load efficiency gains are realized when the economizer gas is only entered into a closed groove on the side that is unloaded second (see explanation in the section on Economizers). Figure 27 demonstrates the effect of asymmetrical capacity control of a single-screw compressor.

Performance. Figures 28 and 29 show typical efficiencies of all single-screw compressor designs. High isentropic and volumetric efficiencies result from internal compression, the absence of suction or discharge valves and their losses, and extremely small clearance volumes. The curves show the importance of selecting the correct volume ratio in fixed-volume-ratio compressors.

Manufacturers' data for operating conditions versus speed should not be extrapolated. Screw compressor performance at reduced speed is usually significantly different from that specified at the normally rated point because of the significant effect of leakage. Performance data normally include information about the degree of liquid subcooling and suction superheating assumed in data.

Applications. Single-screw compressors are widely used as refrigeration compressors, using halocarbon refrigerants, ammonia, and hydrocarbon refrigerants. A single-gate-rotor semi-hermetic version is used in large supermarkets.

Oil-injected and oil-injection-free (OIF) semi-hermetic compressors are widely used for air-conditioning and heat pump service, with compressor sizes ranging from 140 to 1800 kW.

Semi-Hermetic Design. Figure 30 shows a semi-hermetic single-screw compressor. Figure 31 shows a semi-hermetic single-screw compressor using only one gate rotor. This design has been used in large supermarket rack systems. The single-gate-rotor compressor exhibits high efficiency and has been designed for long bearing life, which compensates for the unbalanced load on the screw rotor shaft with increasing bearing size.

Noise and Vibration. The inherently low noise and vibration of single-screw compressors are due to small torque fluctuation and no valves required in the compression chamber. In particular, OIF technology eliminates the need for oil separators, which have traditionally created noise.

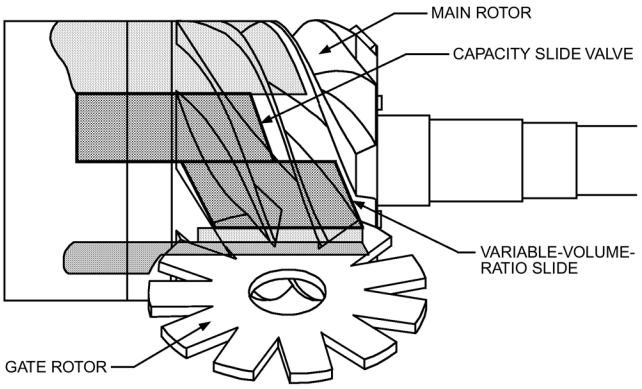


Fig. 26 Capacity Slide in Part-Load Position and Volume Ratio Slide Positioned to Maintain System Volume Ratio

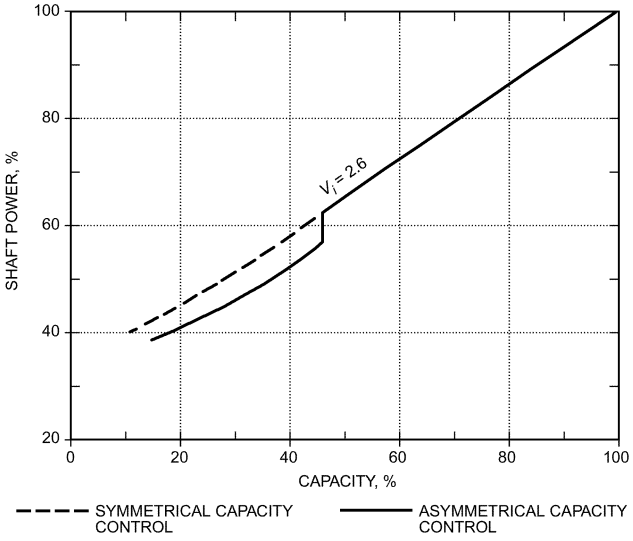


Fig. 27 Part-Load Effect of Symmetrical and Asymmetrical Capacity Control

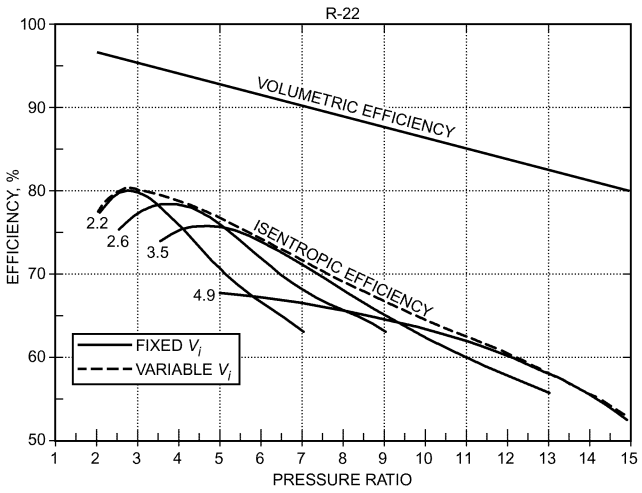


Fig. 28 Typical Open-Compressor Performance on R-22

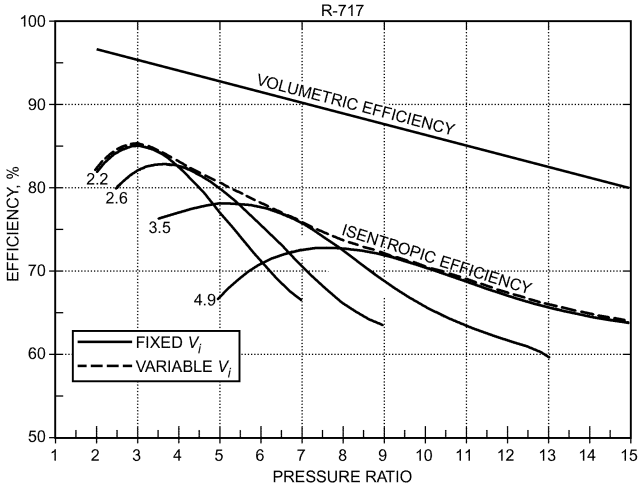


Fig. 29 Typical Compressor Performance on R-717 (Ammonia)

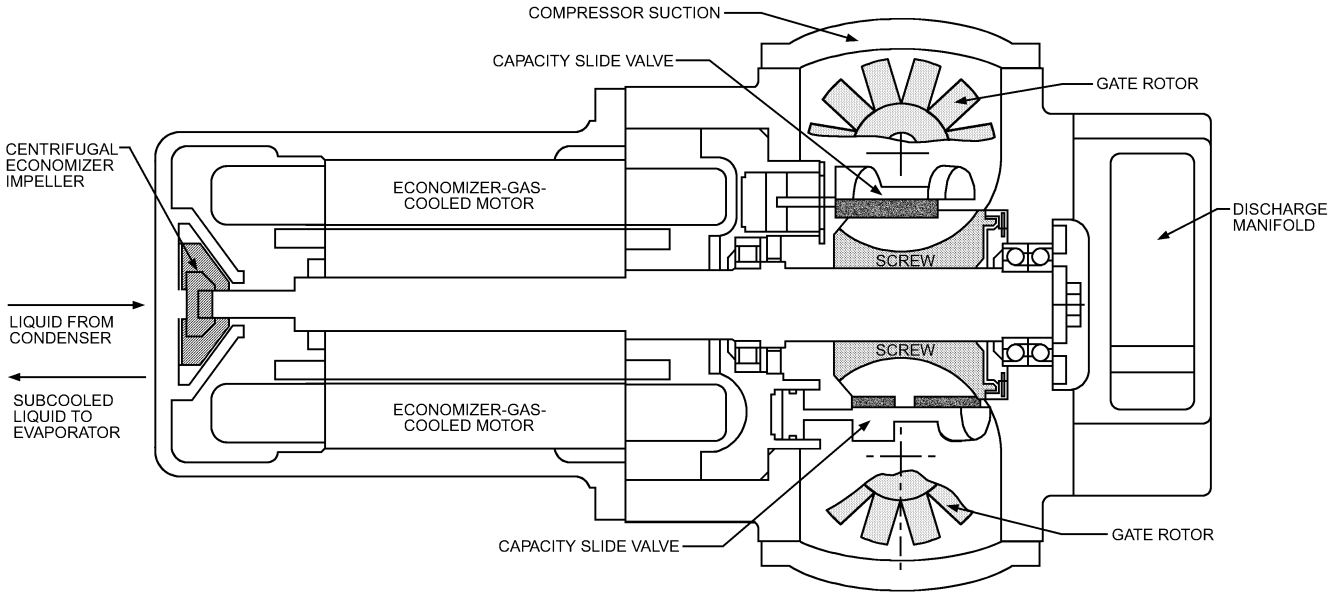


Fig. 30 Typical Semi-Hermetic Single-Screw Compressor

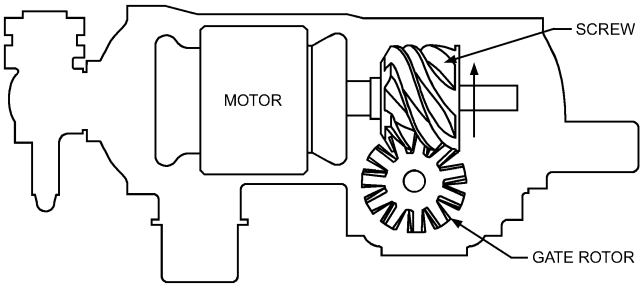


Fig. 31 Single-Gate-Rotor Semi-Hermetic Single-Screw Compressor

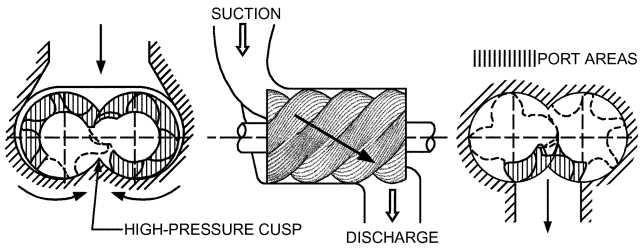


Fig. 32 Twin-Screw Compressor

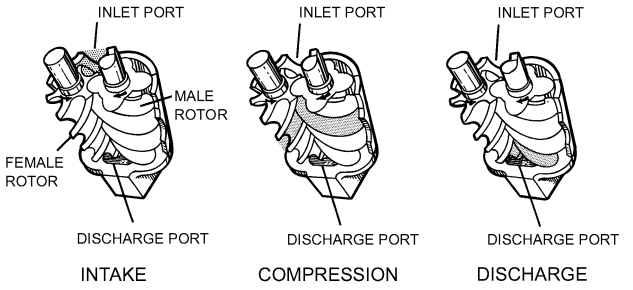


Fig. 33 Twin-Screw Compression Process

Twin-Screw Compressors

Twin screw is the common designation for double helical rotary screw compressors. A twin-screw compressor consists of two mating helically grooved rotors: male (lobes) and female (flutes or gullies) in a stationary housing with inlet and outlet gas ports (Figure 32). Gas flow in the rotors is mainly in an axial direction. Frequently used lobe combinations are 4 + 6, 5 + 6, and 5 + 7 (male + female). For instance, with a four-lobe male rotor, the driver rotates at 3600 rpm; the six-lobe female rotor follows at 2400 rpm. The female rotor can be driven through synchronized timing gears or directly driven by the male rotor on a light oil film. In some applications, it is practical to drive the female rotor, which results in a 50% speed and displacement increase over the male-driven compressor, assuming a 4 + 6 lobe combination. Geared speed increasers are also used on some applications to increase the capacity delivered by a particular compressor size.

Twin helical screws find application in many air-conditioning, refrigeration, and heat pump applications, typically in the industrial and commercial market. Machines can be designed to operate at high or low pressure and are sometimes applied below 2:1 and above 20:1 compression ratios single-stage. Commercially available compressors are suitable for application on the majority of refrigerants.

Compression Process. Compression is obtained by direct volume reduction with pure rotary motion. For clarity, the following description of the three basic compression phases is limited to one male rotor lobe and one female rotor interlobe space (Figure 33).

Suction. As the rotors begin to unmesh, a void is created on both the male side (male thread) and the female side (female thread), and gas is drawn in through the inlet port. As the rotors continue to turn, the interlobe space increases, and gas flows continuously into the compressor. Just before the point at which the interlobe space leaves the inlet port, the entire length of the interlobe space is completely filled with gas.

Compression. Further rotation starts meshing another male lobe with another female interlobe space on the suction end and progressively compresses the gas in the direction of the discharge port.

Thus, the occupied volume of the trapped gas within the interlobe space decreases and the gas pressure consequently increases.

Discharge. At a point determined by the designed built-in volume ratio, the discharge port is uncovered and the compressed gas is discharged by further meshing of the lobe and interlobe space.

During the remeshing period of compression and discharge, a fresh charge is drawn through the inlet on the opposite side of the meshing point. With four male lobes rotating at 3600 rpm, four interlobe volumes are filled and give 14 000 discharges per minute. Because the intake and discharge cycles overlap effectively, gas flow is smooth and continuous.

Mechanical Features.

Rotor Profiles. Helical rotor design started with an asymmetrical point-generated rotor profile, which was only used in compressors with timing gears. The later symmetrical, circular rotor profile is easier to manufacture and can be used with or without timing gears.

Current rotor profiles are normally asymmetrical line-generated profiles, giving higher performance because of better rotor dynamics and decreased leakage area. This design allows female rotor drive, as well as conventional male drive. Rotor profile, blowhole, length of sealing line, quality of sealing line, torque transmission between rotors, rotor-housing clearances, interlobe clearances, and lobe combinations are optimized for specific pressure, temperature, speed, and wet or dry operation. Optimal rotor tip speed is 15 to 40 m/s for wet operation (oil-flooded) and 60 to 120 m s for dry operation.

Rotor Contact and Loading. Contact between the male and female rotors is mainly rolling, primarily at a contact band on each rotor's pitch circle. Rolling at this contact band means that very little wear occurs. However, even a minor sliding motion can generate significant local heat from friction, and if there is not enough gas or lubricant flow at this area, a local scoring may occur that leads to increased internal leakage, higher friction losses, and sometimes mechanical failure because of locked rotors.

Gas Forces. On the driven rotor, the internal gas force always creates a torque in a direction opposite to the direction of rotation. This is known as positive or braking torque. For the undriven rotor, the design can be such that the torque is positive, negative, or zero, except on female-drive designs, where zero or negative torque does not occur. Negative torque occurs when internal gas force tends to drive the rotor. If the average torque on the undriven rotor is near zero, this rotor is subjected to torque reversal as it goes through its phase angles. Under certain conditions, this can cause instability. Torque transmitted between the rotors does not create problems because the rotors are mainly in rolling contact. The transmitted torque from male rotor to female rotor is normally 5 to 25% of input torque, compared to the transmitted torque from female rotor to male rotor, which is normally 50 to 60% of input torque.

Rotors in an operating compressor are subjected to radial, axial, and tilting loads. Tilting loads are radial loads caused by axial loads outside of the rotor center line. Axial load is normally balanced with a balancing piston for larger high-pressure machines (rotor diameter above 100 mm and discharge pressure above 1100 kPa). Balancing pistons are typically close-tolerance, labyrinth-type devices with high-pressure oil or gas on one side and low pressure on the other. They are used to produce a thrust load to offset some of the primary gas loading on the rotors, thus reducing the amount of thrust load the bearings support.

Bearings. Twin-screw compressors normally have either four or six bearings, depending on whether one or two bearings are used for the radial and axial loads. Some designs incorporate multiple rows of smaller bearings per shaft to share loads. Sleeve bearings were used historically to support radial loads in machines with male rotor diameters larger than 150 mm; antifriction bearings were generally applied to smaller machines. However, improvements in antifriction designs and materials have led to compressors with up to 360 mm rotor diameter with full antifriction bearing designs. Cylindrical and tapered roller bearings and various types of ball bearings are used in screw compressors for carrying radial loads; this may lead to an increase in the number of bearings. The most common thrust or axial load-carrying bearings are angular-contact ball bearings, although tapered rollers or tilting pad bearings are used in some machines. Use of moldable polymeric materials with higher temperature limits for bearing cages allows high-speed operation of the compressor at higher discharge temperatures.

General Design. Screw compressors are often designed for particular pressure ranges. Low-pressure compressors have long, high displacement rotors and adequate space to accommodate bearings to handle the relatively light loads. They are frequently designed without thrust balance pistons, because the bearings alone can handle the low thrust loads and still maintain good life.

High-pressure compressors have short, strong rotors (shallow grooves) and therefore have space for large bearings. Larger compressors are normally designed with balancing pistons for high thrust bearing life.

Rotor Materials. Rotors are normally made of steel, but aluminum, cast iron, and nodular iron are used in some applications. Special surface treatment or coatings can be used to reduce wear and improve oil adhesion.

Capacity Control. As with all positive-displacement compressors, both speed modulation and suction throttling can reduce the volume of gas drawn into a screw compressor. Ideal capacity modulation for any compressor would be (1) continuous modulation from 100% to less than 10%, (2) good part-load efficiency, (3) unloaded starting, and (4) high reliability throughout the operational range. However, not all applications need ideal capacity modulation. Variable compressor displacement and variable speed are the best means for meeting these criteria. Various mechanisms achieve variable displacement, depending on the requirements of a particular application.

Capacity Slide Valve. A slide valve for capacity control is a valve with sliding action parallel to the rotor bores, within or close to the high-pressure region. It reduces the active length of the housing profile, thus controlling compressor displacement and capacity. There are two types of capacity slide valves:

- Capacity slide valves regulating the discharge port are located in the high-pressure cusp region. They control capacity as well as the location of the radial discharge port at part load. The axial discharge port is designed for a volume ratio giving good part-load performance without losing full-load performance. Figure 34 shows a schematic of the most common arrangement.

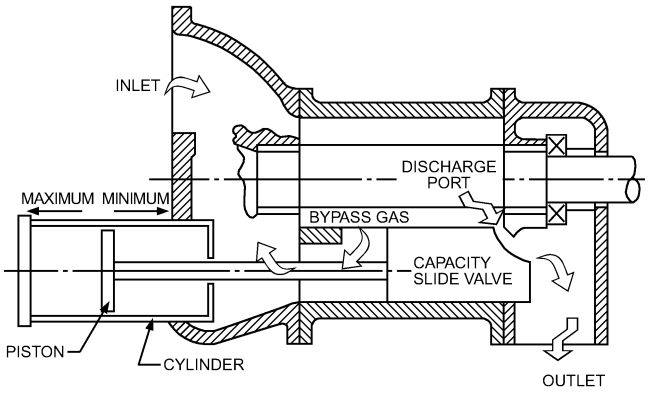


Fig. 34 Slide Valve Unloading Mechanism

- Capacity slide valves *not* regulating the discharge port outside the high-pressure cusp region control only capacity.

The first type is most common. It is generally the most efficient capacity reduction method, because of its indirect correction of built-in volume (compression) ratio at part load and its ability to give large volume reductions without large movement of the slide valve.

Capacity Slot Valve. A capacity slot valve consists of a number of slots that follow the rotor helix and face one or both rotor bores. The slots are gradually opened or closed with a plunger or turn valve. These recesses in the casing wall increase the volume of compression space and also create leakage paths over the lobe tips. The result is somewhat lower full-load performance compared to a design without slots.

Capacity Lift Valve. Capacity lift valves or plug valves are movable plugs in one or both rotor bores (with radial or axial lifting action) that regulate the actual start of compression. These valves control capacity in a finite number of steps, rather than by the infinite control of a conventional slide valve (Figure 35).

Neither slot nor lift valves offer quite as good efficiency at part load as a slide valve, because they do not relocate the radial discharge port. Thus, undercompression losses at part load can be expected if machines have the correct volume (compression) ratio for full-load operation and the pressure ratio at part load does not reduce.

Volume (Compression) Ratio. In all positive-displacement rotary compressors with fixed port location, the degree of compression in the rotor thread is determined by the location of suction and discharge ports. The built-in volume (compression) ratio of screw compressors is defined as the ratio of volume of the thread at the start of compression to the volume of the same thread when it begins to open to the discharge port. The suction port must be located to trap the maximum suction charge; hence, the compression ratio is determined by the location of the discharge port.

Only suction pressure and compression volume ratio determine the internal pressure achieved before opening to discharge. However, condensing and evaporating temperatures determine discharge pressure and compression ratio in piping that leads to the compressor. Any mismatch between internal and system discharge pressures results in under- or overcompression loss and lower efficiency.

If the operating conditions of the system seldom change, it is possible to specify a fixed-volume-ratio compressor that will give good efficiency. Compressor manufacturers normally make compressors with three or four possible discharge port sizes that correspond to system conditions encountered frequently. Generally, the designer is responsible for specifying a compressor that most closely matches expected pressure conditions.

The required compression ratio for a particular application can be determined as follows:

$$CR = PR^{1/k} \tag{13}$$

where

CR = compression ratio
PR = pressure ratio = p_d/p_s
p_d = expected discharge pressure (absolute)
p_s = expected suction pressure (absolute)
k = isentropic coefficient for refrigerant used, from refrigerant tables (e.g., Lemmon et al. [2002])

Usually, in slide-valve-equipped compressors, the radial discharge port is located in the discharge end of the slide valve. For a given ratio L/D of rotor length to rotor diameter and a given stop position, a short slide valve gives a low volume ratio, and a long slide valve gives a higher compression ratio. The difference in length basically locates the discharge port earlier or later in the compression process. Different-length slide valves allow changing the compression ratio of a given compressor, although disassembly is required.

Variable Volume (Compression) Ratio. While operating, some twin-screw compressors adjust the compressor volume ratio to the most efficient ratio for whatever pressures are encountered.

In fixed-volume-ratio compressors, the slide valve motion toward the inlet end of the machine is stopped when it comes in contact with the rotor housing in that area. In most common variable-volume-ratio machines, this portion of the rotor housing has been replaced with a second slide, the movable slide stop, which can be actuated to different locations in the slide valve bore (Figure 36).

By moving the slides back and forth, the radial discharge port can be relocated during operation to match the compressor volume ratio to the optimum. This added flexibility allows operation at different suction and discharge pressure while maintaining maximum efficiency. Comparative efficiencies of fixed- and variable-volume-ratio screw compressors are shown in Figure 37 for full-load oper-

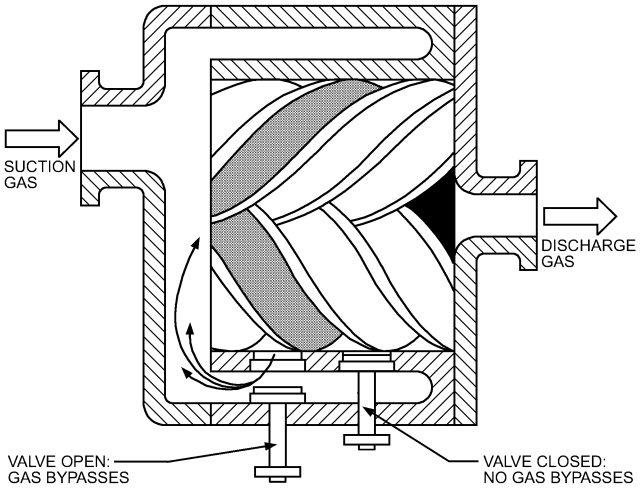


Fig. 35 Lift Valve Unloading Mechanism

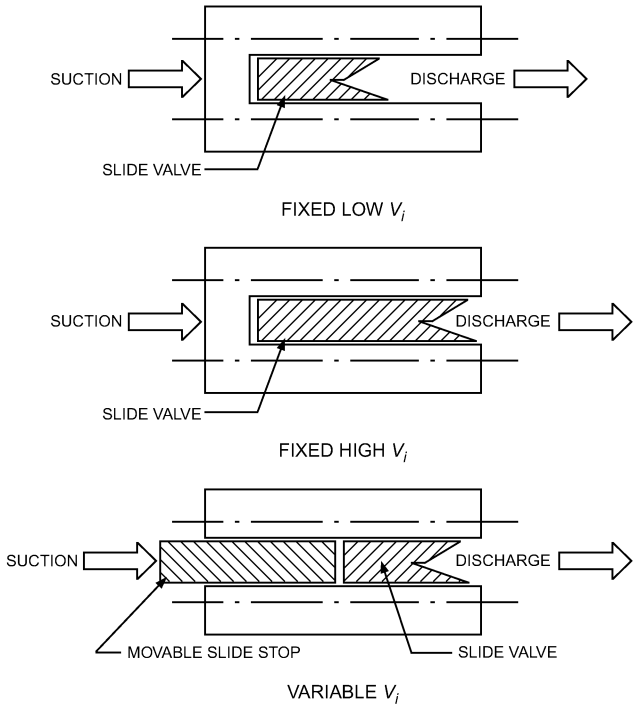


Fig. 36 View of Fixed- and Variable-Volume-Ratio (V_i) Slide Valves from Above

ation on ammonia and R-22 refrigerants. The figure shows that a variable-volume-ratio compressor efficiency curve encompasses the peak efficiencies of compressors with fixed volume ratio over a wide range of pressure ratio. Following are other secondary effects of a variable-volume ratio:

- Less oil foam in oil separator (no overcompression)
- Less oil carried over into the refrigeration system (because of less oil foam in oil separator)
- Extended bearing life; minimized load on bearings
- Extended efficient operating range with economizer discharge port corrected for flash gas from economizer, as well as gas from suction
- Less noise
- Lower discharge temperatures and oil cooler heat rejection

The greater the changes in either suction or condensing pressure, the more benefits are possible with a variable-volume ratio. Efficiency improvement as high as 30% is possible, depending on the application, refrigerant, and operating range.

Performance Characteristics. Figure 37 shows the full-load efficiency of a modern twin-screw compressor. Values for both fixed- and variable-volume-ratio compressors without economizers are shown. High isentropic and volumetric efficiencies result from internal compression, the absence of suction or discharge valves, and small clearance volume. The curves show that, although volumetric efficiency depends little on the choice of volume ratio, isentropic efficiency depends strongly on it. Performance data usually note the degree of liquid subcooling and suction superheating assumed. If an economizer is used, the pressure drop and temperature of liquid approaching the economizer should be specified.

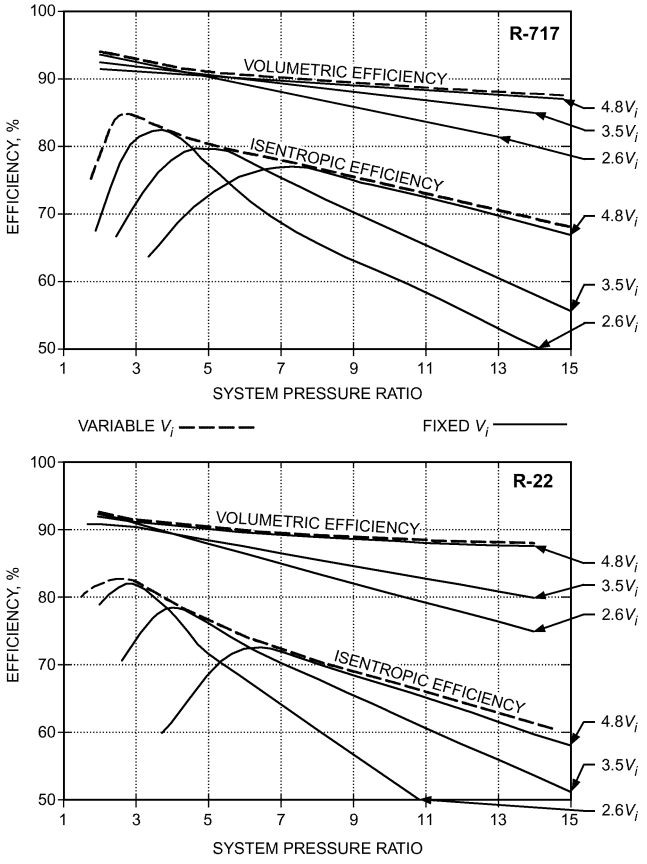


Fig. 37 Twin-Screw Compressor Efficiency Curves

Noise. The most significant sources of noise in screw compressors are rotor contact and discharge pulsations. Adequate lubrication and discharge port design can significantly alleviate this issue. If screws are driven by gears, gear noise may become dominant.

Oil Injection. Two primary types of compressor lubrication systems are used in twin-screw compressors: dry and oil-flooded.

Dry Operation (No Rotor Contact). Because the two rotors in twin-screw compressors are parallel, timing gears are a practical means of synchronizing the rotors so that they do not touch each other. Eliminating rotor contact eliminates the need for lubrication in the compression area; however, a small amount of oil may be needed to provide sealing. Initial screw compressor designs were based on this approach, and dry screws are still used in the gas process industry and in some transportation applications.

Synchronized twin-screw compressors once required high rotor tip speed to minimize leakage, and thus were noisy. However, with current profile technology, the synchronized compressor can run at a lower tip speed and higher pressure ratio, giving quieter operation. The added cost of timing gears and internal seals generally make the dry screw more expensive than an oil-flooded screw for normal refrigeration or air conditioning.

Oil-Flooded Operation. The oil-flooded twin-screw compressor is the most common type of screw compressor used in refrigeration and air conditioning. Oil-flooded compressors typically have oil supplied to the compression area at a volume rate of about 0.5% of the displacement volume. Part of this oil is used for lubricating bearings and shaft seal. Different oils are used, as required by the refrigerant or gas application. In the case of oil injection, oil is normally injected into a closed thread through ports in the moving slide valve and/or through stationary ports in the casing.

The oil fulfills three primary purposes: sealing, cooling, and lubrication. It tends to fill any leakage paths between and around the rotors. This keeps volumetric efficiency high, even at high compression ratios. Often, compressor volumetric efficiency exceeds 85%, even at 25:1 single stage (ammonia, 190 mm rotor diameter). High internal oil circulation reduces the influence of speed on compressor performance and lessens operational noise. Oil transfers much of the heat of compression from the gas to the oil, keeping the typical discharge temperature below 120°C, which allows high compression ratios without the danger of breaking down the refrigerant or oil. Lubrication by the oil protects bearings, seals, and rotor contact areas.

The ability of a screw compressor to tolerate oil also permits the compressor to handle a certain amount of liquid, as long as the liquid quantity is not large enough to lock the rotors hydraulically.

Oil Separation and Cooling. Oil injection requires an oil separator to remove oil from the high-pressure refrigerant. Coalescing separation equipment routinely gives less than 5 mg/kg oil in the circulated refrigerant. Compressors used in direct-expansion (DX) systems and/or on packaged units have less-efficient separation capability.

Oil injection is normally achieved by one of two methods: (l) with a continuously running oil pump capable of generating an oil pressure of 200 to 300 kPa over compressor discharge pressure, representing 0.3 to 1.0% of compressor motor power; or (2) with some compressors, oil can be injected automatically without a pump because of the pressure difference between the oil reservoir (discharge pressure) and the reduced pressure in an intermediate compression chamber.

Depending on the refrigerant and operating conditions, screw compressors can operate with or without oil cooling. There are performance advantages in maintaining low discharge-gas temperature by oil cooling. One cooling method is by direct injection of liquid refrigerant into the compression process. The amount of liquid injected is normally controlled by sensing the discharge tempera-

ture and injecting enough liquid to maintain a constant temperature. Some injected liquid mixes with the oil and leaks to lower-pressure threads, where it tends to raise pressure and reduce the amount of gas the compressor can draw in. Also, any liquid that has time to absorb heat and expand to vapor must be recompressed, which tends to raise absorbed power levels. Compressors are designed with liquid injection ports that inject liquid as late as possible in the compression to minimize capacity and power penalties. Typical penalties for liquid injection are in the 1 to 10% range, depending on the compression ratio. Because of this, and the danger of excessive lubricant dilution, direct liquid injection has more stringent limits than other oil-cooling methods.

Another method of oil cooling draws liquid from the receiver with a small refrigerant pump and injects it directly into the compressor discharge line. The power penalty in this method is the pump power (about 0.75 kW for compressors up to 750 kW).

In the third method, oil is cooled outside the compressor between the oil reservoir and the point of injection. Various configurations of heat exchangers are available for this purpose, and oil cooler heat rejection can be accomplished by (1) separate water supply, (2) chiller water on a packaged unit, (3) condenser water on a packaged unit, (4) water from an evaporative condenser sump, (5) forced air-cooled oil cooler, (6) liquid refrigerant, and (7) high-pressure liquid recirculation (thermosiphon).

External oil coolers using water or other means from a source independent of the condenser allow condenser size to be reduced by an amount corresponding to the oil cooler capacity. Where oil is cooled within the refrigerant system by means such as (1) direct injection of liquid refrigerant into the compression process or the discharge line, (2) direct expansion of fluid in an external heat exchanger, (3) using chiller water on a packaged unit, (4) recirculating high-pressure liquid from the condenser, or (5) water from an evaporative condenser sump, the condenser must be sized for the total heat rejection (i.e., evaporator load plus shaft power for open compressors, and input power for hermetic compressors).

With an external oil cooler, the mass flow rate of oil injected into the compressor is usually determined by the desired discharge temperature rather than by the compressor sealing requirements, because oil acts predominantly as a heat transfer medium. Conversely, with direct liquid injection cooling, the oil requirement is dictated by the compressor lubrication and sealing needs.

Economizers. Twin-screw compressors are available with a secondary suction port between the primary compressor suction and discharge ports. This port can accept a second suction load at a pressure above the primary evaporator, or flash gas from a liquid subcooler vessel, known as an economizer.

In operation, gas is drawn into the rotor thread from the suction line. The thread is then sealed in sequence and compression begins. An additional charge may be added to the closed thread through a suitably placed port in the casing or sliding valve. The port is connected to an intermediate gas source at a pressure slightly higher than that reached in the compression process at that time. Both original and additional charges are then compressed to discharge conditions.

When the port is used as an economizer, some high-pressure liquid is vaporized at the side port pressure and subcools the remaining high-pressure liquid nearly to the saturation temperature at operating-side port pressure. Because this has little effect on compressor suction capacity, the effective refrigerating capacity of the compressor is increased by the increased heat absorption capacity of the liquid entering the evaporator. Furthermore, the only additional mass flow the compressor must handle is the flash gas entering a closed thread, which is above suction pressure. Thus, under most conditions, the capacity improvement is accompanied by an efficiency improvement.

Economizers become effective when the pressure ratio is about two and above (depending on volume ratio). Subcooling can be made with a direct-expansion shell-and-tube or plate heat exchanger, flash tank, or shell-and-coil intercooler.

As twin-screw compressors are unloaded, economizer pressure with a fixed port falls toward suction pressure. The additional capacity and improved efficiency of the economizer system is no longer available below a certain percentage of capacity, depending on design. Some compressors have the economizer port in the slide valve. This allows the economizer to be active down to the lowest percentage of capacity.

Hermetic and Semi-Hermetic Compressors. Hermetic and semi-hermetic screw compressors are commercially available through 700 kW of refrigeration effect using R-22 or equivalent HFCs. Hermetic motors can operate under discharge, suction, or intermediate pressure. Motor cooling can be with gas, oil, and/or liquid refrigerant. Oil separation for these types of compressors may be accomplished with either an integrated oil separator or a separately mounted oil separator in the system. Figures 38 to 41 show four types of fixed-speed twin-screw compressors with slide valve unloading systems. For the lower capacity range (25 to 60 kW), welded-shell horizontal hermetic compressors are also available. Because of their smooth running characteristics, small size, and good capability for frequency inverter drive (20 to 87 Hz), they are preferable for railway and other transportation air-conditioning systems.

The increasing application of frequency-inverter drives for highly efficient capacity modulation by speed variation resulted in numerous further developments. Twin-screw technology in general shows very good potential for increasing operational speed above synchronous levels (3000 rpm at 50 Hz, 3600 rpm at 60 Hz), thus providing higher cooling capacity at full-load conditions as well as

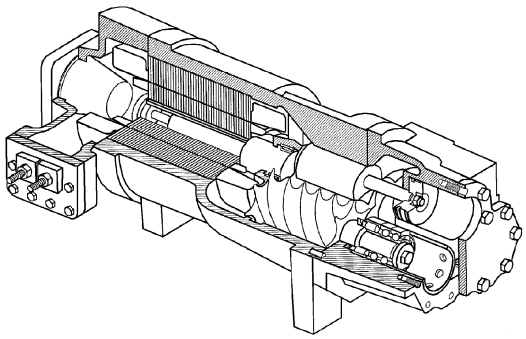


Fig. 38 Semi-Hermetic Twin-Screw Compressor with Suction-Gas-Cooled Motor and Slide Valve Unloading Mechanism

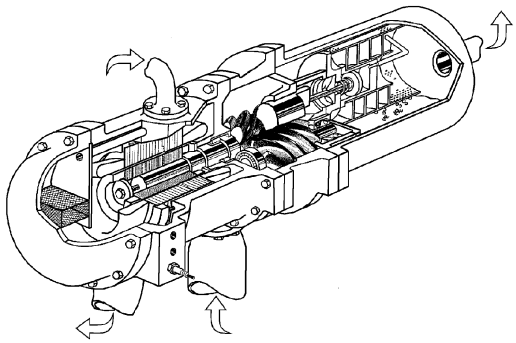


Fig. 39 Semi-Hermetic Twin-Screw Compressor with Motor Housing Used as Economizer; Built-In Oil Separator, and Slide Valve Unloading Mechanism

a wider speed range for capacity modulation. Consequently, the nominal displacement and physical size of the compressor can be reduced, which can reduce cost to partly compensate for the extra cost of the inverter drive.

Besides individually packaging the compressor with an external frequency inverter (air-, water-, or refrigerant-cooled), some recent designs include an integrated, refrigerant-cooled drive. Because of the very intensive inverter cooling, this solution can be very compact. There is also no need for maintenance, and ambient temperature conditions do not influence performance and life span.

For the lowest possible efficiency losses, the evaporated refrigerant leaving the cold plate (also the base frame for the inverter assembly) is sucked into a closed pocket of the rotor profile. Figure 42 shows a sectional drawing of a compressor with an integrated refrigerant-cooled inverter.

3.4 SCROLL COMPRESSORS

Scroll compressors are orbital motion, positive-displacement machines that compress gas using two interfitting, spiral-shaped scroll members (Figure 43). They are currently used in residential and commercial air-conditioning, refrigeration, and heat pump applications as well as in automotive air conditioning. In addition, scroll compressors are being applied in emerging markets requiring the compression of carbon dioxide, helium, and natural gas. The size and application range of scroll designs indicate scroll compressors' potential for new applications.

To function effectively with both high efficiency and low noise, a scroll compressor requires close-tolerance machining of the scroll members, as is now available with computer numerical control (CNC) manufacturing technology. Design features such as axial and radial compliance have also been proven necessary for most designs to meet the high-performance and low-variability requirements of high-volume manufacturing environments.

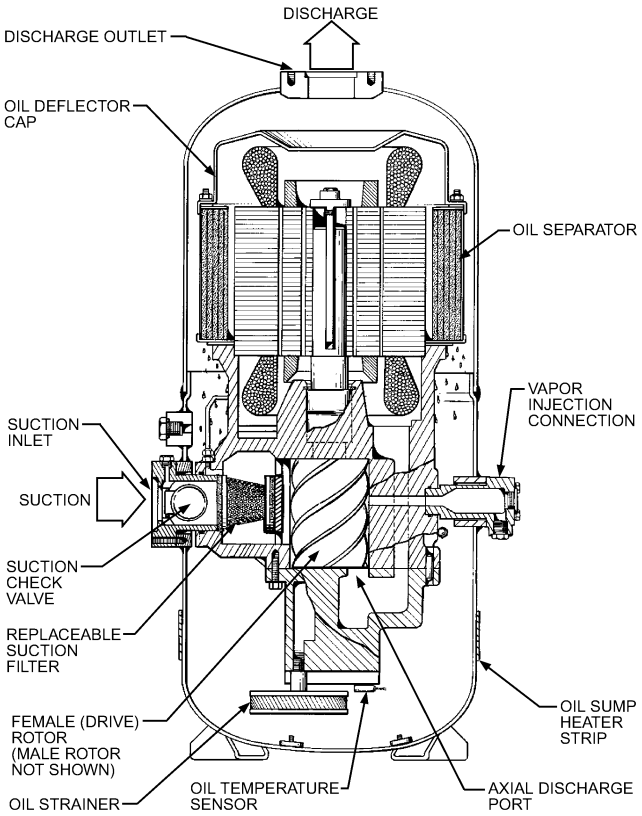


Fig. 40 Vertical, Discharge-Cooled, Hermetic Twin-Screw Compressor

Mechanical Features

Scroll Members and Compression. In a vertical scroll compressor as shown in Figure 44, the scroll components consist of a lower (orbiting) scroll and an upper nonrotating scroll, often referred to as a "fixed" scroll, although it can by design move axially to support the gas sealing process. Gas sealing is critical to the performance advantage of scroll compressors and must be accomplished at both the vane tips and bases of the intermeshed scroll pair and at the flank contact locations. Tip/base sealing is generally considered more critical than flank sealing, with leakage control requiring significantly smaller tolerances.

Scroll members are typically a geometrically matched pair, assembled 180° out of phase. Each scroll member is open on one end of the vane and bound by a base plate on the other. The two

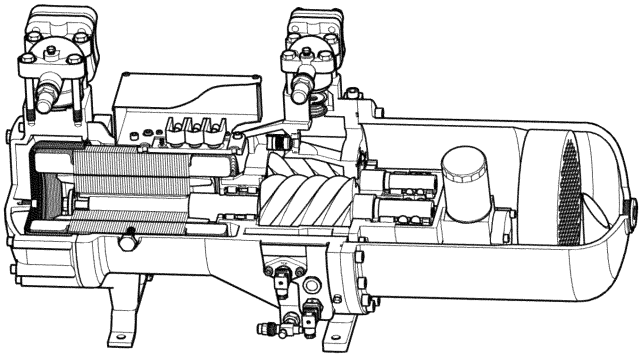


Fig. 41 Semi-Hermetic Twin-Screw Compressor with Suction-Gas-Cooled Motor, Slide Valve Unloading Mechanism, Economizer Port in Slide Valve, and Built-In Oil Separator

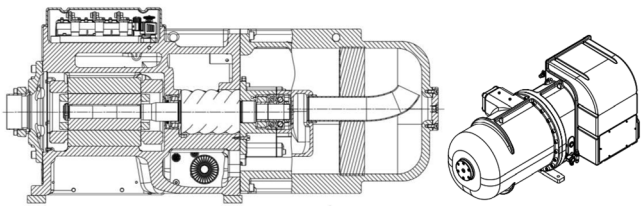


Fig. 42 Semi-Hermetic Twin-Screw Compressor with Suction-Gas-Cooled Motor, Refrigerant-Cooled Frequency Inverter, Means for V_i Control, and Built-In Oil Separator

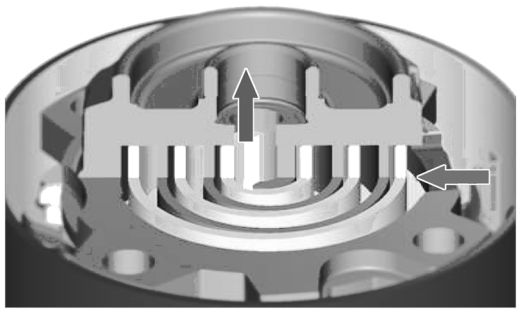


Fig. 43 Interfitted Scroll Members

scrolls are fitted to form pockets between their respective base plates and various lines of contact between their vane walls. One scroll is held fixed, while the other moves in an orbital path with respect to the first. The flanks of the scrolls remain in contact, although the contact locations move progressively inward. Relative rotation between the pair is typically prevented by an interconnecting Oldham coupling, which physically connects the scrolls and permits all planar motion between them except relative rotation.

An alternative approach to scroll compression creates relative orbital motion via two scrolls synchronously rotating about noncoincident axes. As in the former case, an interconnecting Oldham coupling maintains a relative angle between the pair of scrolls (Morishita et al. 1988).

Compression is accomplished by sealing suction gas in pockets of a given volume at the outer periphery of the scrolls and progressively reducing the size of those pockets as the scroll relative motion moves compressed gas inwards toward the discharge port. Figure 45 shows the sequence of suction, compression, and discharge phases. As the outermost pockets are sealed off (Figure 45A), the trapped gas is at suction pressure and has just entered the compression process. At stages B through F, orbiting motion moves the gas toward the center of the scroll pair, and pressure rises as pocket volumes are reduced. At stage G, the gas reaches the central discharge port and begins to exit from the scrolls. Stages A through H in Figure 45 show that two distinct compression paths operate simultaneously in a scroll set. The discharge process is nearly continuous, because new pockets reach the discharge stage very shortly after the previous discharge pockets have been evacuated. Scroll compression embodies a fixed, built-in volume ratio defined by the scroll geometry and the discharge port location. This feature provides the scroll compressor with different performance characteristics than with variable-volume-ratio (VVR) designs, such as reciprocating and conventional rolling-piston rotary compressors.

Both high- and low-side pressure vessels are used with scroll designs. In the former, the entire compressor is at discharge pressure, except for the outer areas of the scroll set. Suction gas is introduced into the suction port of the scrolls through piping, which keeps it isolated from the rest of the compressor. Discharge gas is directed into the compressor housing, which acts as a plenum for both discharge gas pulsations and oil separation. In the low-side type, most of the housing is at suction pressure, and the discharge gas exiting from the scrolls is routed outside the shell, generally through a discrete or integral plenum.

Radial Compliance. This feature enhances flank sealing and allows the orbiting scroll to follow a flexible path defined by its contact with the fixed scroll. In one type of radial compliance, a sliding "unloader" bushing is fitted onto the crankshaft eccentric pin in such a way that it directs the radial motion of the orbiting scroll. The orbiting scroll is mounted over this bushing through a drive bearing so that the scroll may now move radially in and out to accommodate variations in orbit radius caused by machining and assembly toler-

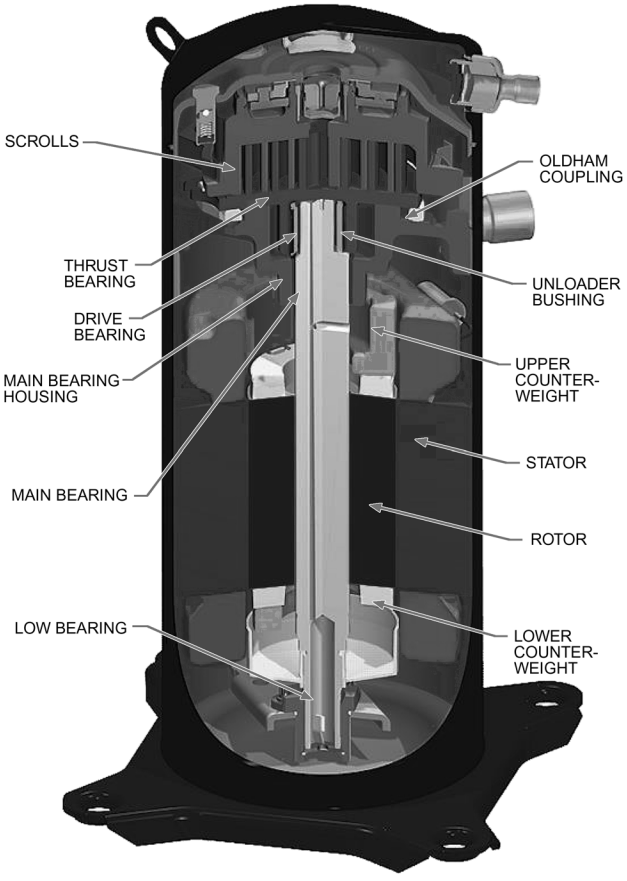


Fig. 44 Components of Scroll Compressor
(Elson et al. 2008)

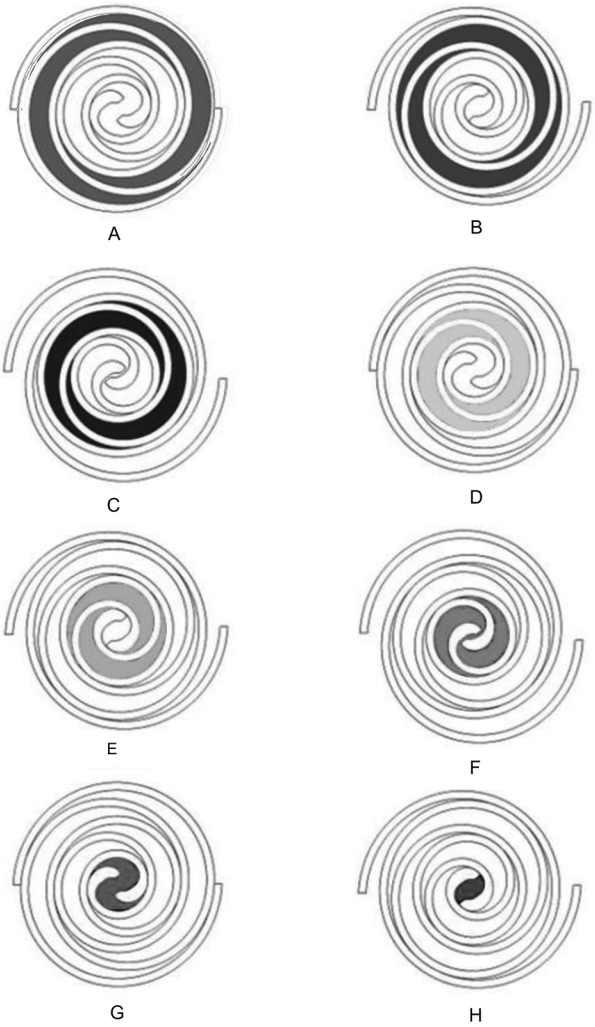


Fig. 45 Scroll Compression Process
(Purvis 1987)

ances. This feature, along with the orbiting motion of the orbiting scroll, tends to keep the flanks in continuous contact and reduce impacts on the flanks that can result from intermittent contact. Sufficient clearance in the pin/unloader assembly also allows the scroll flanks to separate fully as needed.

In some designs, the mass of the orbiting scroll is selected so that centrifugal force overcomes radial gas compression forces that would otherwise keep the flanks separated. In other designs, the drive is designed so that the influence of centrifugal force is partly reduced but still sufficient to overcome the radial gas compression force (McCullough 1975). Radial compliance has the added benefit of increasing resistance to liquid slugging and contaminants, because the orbiting scroll can "unload" or move inward as it encounters obstacles or nonuniform hydraulic pressures (Bush and Elson 1988).

Axial Compliance. With this feature, an adjustable axial pressure maintains sealing contact between the scroll tips and bases while running. This pressure is released when the unit is shut down, allowing the compressor to start unloaded and to approach full operational speed before a significant load is encountered. This concept obviates the use of tip seals, eliminating them as a potential source of wear and leakage. With the scroll tips bearing directly on the opposite base plates and with suitable lubrication, sealing tends to improve over time. Axial compliance can be implemented on either the orbiting scroll or the upper fixed scroll (Caillat et al. 1988; Tojo et al. 1982). Axial compliance may also require additional sealing of the discharge gas path with respect to the suction side of the compressor.

Noncompliant Designs. In designs lacking radial compliance, the orbiting scroll takes a fixed orbital path to provide a small clearance between the vanes of the orbiting and fixed scrolls while also allowing for small irregularities between the vane flanks caused by flank machining variation. Oil injection into the scrolls is a method used with these designs to control excess leakage and improve performance, but it entails some risk of increasing oil circulation in the refrigeration system.

In the axial direction, the position of both scrolls remains fixed, and flexible seals fitted into machined grooves on the tips of both scrolls accomplish tip sealing. These seals are pressure loaded and axially compliant to enhance uniform contact and improve scroll tip/base sealing (McCullough and Shaffer 1976; Sauls 1983).

Bearing System. The bearing system consists of a drive bearing mounted in the orbiting scroll and two main bearings. The main bearings are either of the cantilevered type (main bearings on same side of the motor as the scrolls) or consist of a main bearing on either side of the motor (see Figure 44). All bearing load vectors rotate through a full 360° because of the nature of the drive load. The orbiting scroll is supported axially by a thrust bearing on a housing that is part of the internal frame or is mounted directly to the compressor shell.

Capacity Control

Various capacity control approaches are currently used by the scroll compressor industry to better match capacity needs determined by ambient temperature variation. Capacity control methods include variable speed, variable displacement, and economized vapor injection.

Variable-Speed Scroll Compressor. Conventional air-conditioning products use a constant-speed motor to drive the compressor. A variable-speed scroll compressor uses an inverter drive to convert a fixed-frequency alternating current into one with adjustable voltage and frequency, which allows variation of the motor's rotating speed. The compressor uses either an induction or a permanent magnet motor. Typical operating frequency varies between 15 and 150 Hz. The capacity provided by the machine is nearly directly proportional to its running frequency.

Variable-Displacement Scroll Compressor. This capacity control mechanism incorporates porting holes in the fixed or upper scroll member. The control mechanism disconnects or connects compression chambers to the suction side by respectively closing or opening the porting holes. One such design, shown in Figure 46, uses a solenoid-actuated circular ring to open and close large ports in the upper scroll member. When all porting holes are closed, the compressor runs at full capacity; opening all porting holes to the suction side yields the smallest capacity. Thus, by opening or closing a different number of porting holes, variable cooling or heating capability is provided. The number of different capacities and extent of the capacity reduction available are governed by the locations of the ports in reference to full-capacity suction seal-off. This approach is also generally limited to a 1/3 capacity reduction, because of porting access to the outer-scroll compression pockets.

For system applications requiring a higher percentage of capacity reduction, scroll compressors have been developed with multistep digital capacity using opening and closing of the scroll elements in the axial direction. With this approach, shown in Figure 47, the upper scroll element is mechanically separated from the lower element through a lifting piston assembly and a logic-controlled solenoid valve that vents the top side of the piston to the low-pressure side of the compressor. With axial scroll separation, the mass flow from the compressor can be controlled from 10 to 100%, with typical time cycles for this flow variation being 10 to 20 s. Because of the thermal inertia of the condenser coil volume and the restriction given by the system expansion valve, the effect of this pulsed mass flow is smoothed such that the system evaporator sees an integrated net mass flow with minimal flow variation. Exceptional system cooling capacity control has been demonstrated with this approach in several challenging applications, including multiple-evaporator air conditioning and marine container refrigeration, where a single refrigeration system must maintain cargo temperature for both fresh and frozen goods at all ambient temperatures.

Vapor Injection (Economizer Cycle). The scroll compression process with intermediate compression pockets makes it possible to apply economized vapor injection to a single scroll compressor to benefit scroll performance through the injection of high-pressure vapor via injection ports (Figure 48). Through this cycle that can be compared to a two-stage compression process, additional liquid refrigerant subcooling (and evaporator capacity) is achieved by flashing a portion of the high-pressure condenser liquid refrigerant to a heat exchanger through which also flows the remaining liquid refrigerant. The net benefit is an evaporator capacity increase as much as 60% at high-pressure-ratio operating conditions such as

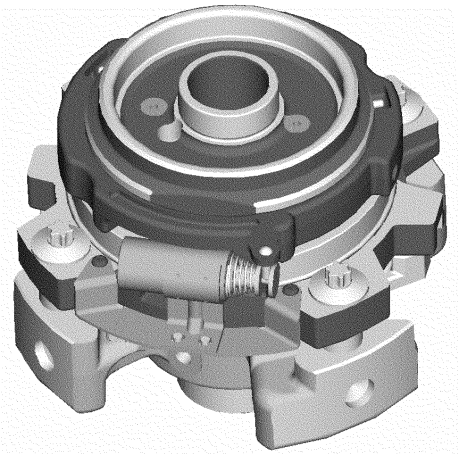


Fig. 46 Two-Step Modulation

low-temperature refrigeration. An equally important benefit is a net efficiency gain of up to 20 to 30% because of a smaller percentage increase in compression work relative to the capacity increase. Scroll compressors with vapor injection capability have also improved system heating performance for low-ambient residential heating where supplemental heating (electric resistance) has been necessary to meet the heat load.

Energy Efficiency

Scroll technology offers an advantage in high energy efficiency for a number of reasons. Large suction and discharge ports and a smooth compression process reduce pressure losses typically incurred in other compressor types. The physical separation of these processes also reduces heat transfer to the suction gas. Isentropic efficiency in the range of 75% is possible at scroll design pressure ratios while maintaining relatively high efficiency throughout the practical range of pressure ratios for air-conditioning applications (Figure 49). In addition, the absence of reexpansion volumes and the continuous-flow process result in high volumetric efficiency over a wide range of operating conditions.

Depending on the application and refrigerant choice, the design pressure ratio of the scroll elements is generally selected to achieve optimal performance at system rating conditions. This basic design approach can also be further optimized for higher-pressure-ratio refrigeration and heat pump applications (under compression) by adding a dynamic discharge valve at the discharge port of the fixed scroll. This discharge valve is particularly important for pressure ratios of 6 to 8 or higher, when the scroll design pressure ratio is significantly below the compressor operating pressure ratio such that gas backflow and recompression can result in excessive compression work and inefficiency.

To minimize overcompression losses associated with low operating pressure ratios, additional discharge ports can be located in the pockets between the initial suction pockets and the main discharge port. This allows the scroll to operate at a variable volume ratio (VVR) determined by both the location of the primary discharge port and the additional ports shown in Figure 50.

Scroll compressors offer a flatter capacity versus the outdoor ambient curve than compressors with built-in clearance volume, which means they can more closely approach indoor cooling or heating requirements at high-demand conditions. As a result, the

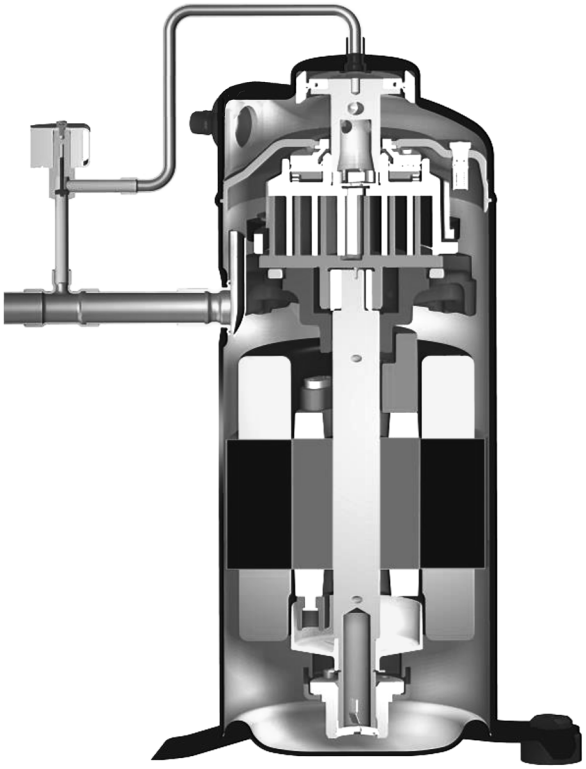


Fig. 47 Multistep Modulation

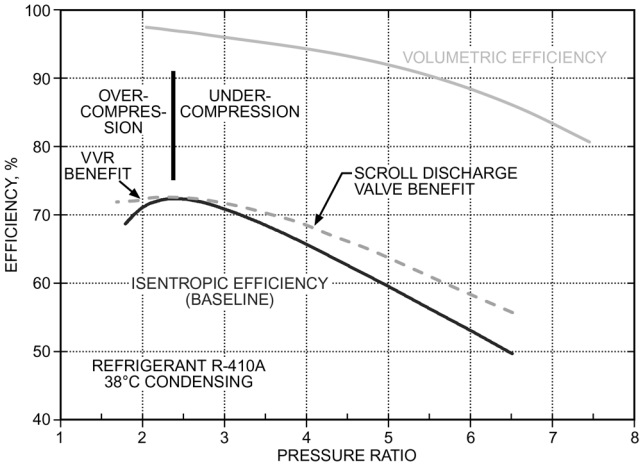


Fig. 49 Volumetric and Isentropic Efficiency for Scroll Compressors

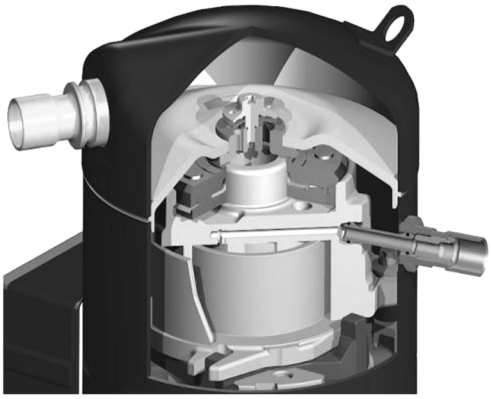


Fig. 48 Scroll with Vapor Injection

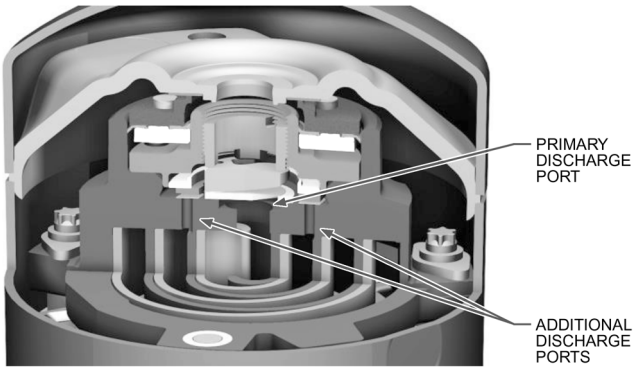


Fig. 50 Variable Volume Ratio (VVR)

heat pump mode requires less supplemental heating, and the cooling mode is more comfortable, because cycling decreases as demand decreases (Figure 51). Scroll compressors available for the residential North American market are typically specified as producing AHRI operating efficiencies (coefficients of performance [COPs]) in the range of 2.8 to 3.1 using R-410A refrigerant.

Noise and Vibration

Scroll compressors have an inherent potential for low sound and vibration. They include minimal moving parts compared to other compressor technologies. Their continuous suction-compression-discharge process and low-gas-pressure pulsation help keep system noise and vibration low. A near-perfect dynamic balancing of the orbiting scroll inertia with counterweights eliminates possible mechanical vibration caused by rotating parts. Also, smooth surface finish and accurate machining of the vane profiles and base plates of both scroll members (a requirement for low gas leakage) aid in minimal impact noise from vane contact. A typical residential scroll compressor sound spectrum (Figure 52) shows a relatively uniform sound characteristic with minimal low-frequency content, which helps reduce sound transmission to the residential environment.

Operation and Maintenance

Most scroll compressors used today are hermetic, requiring virtually no maintenance or special operation procedures. However, for proper application and operation, the compressor manufacturer's manual should be followed.

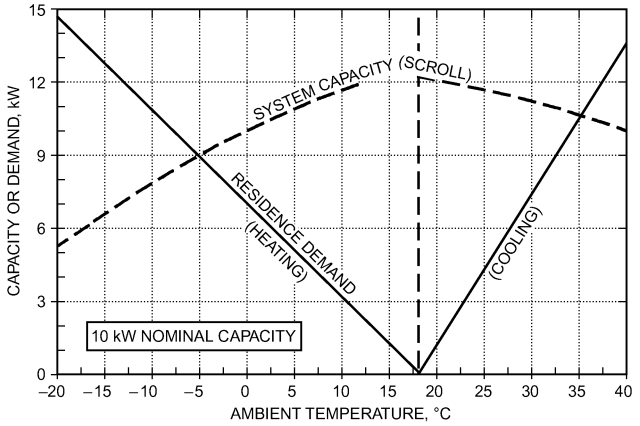


Fig. 51 Scroll Capacity Versus Residence Demand
(Purvis 1987)

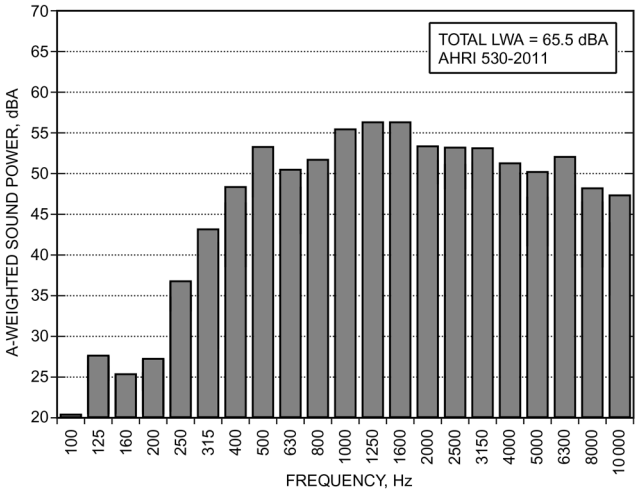


Fig. 52 Typical Residential Scroll Sound Spectrum

3.5 TROCHOIDAL COMPRESSORS

Trochoidal compressors are small, rotary, positive-displacement compressors that can run at high speed up to 9000 rpm. They are manufactured in various configurations. Trochoidal curvatures can be produced by the rolling motion of one circle outside or inside the circumference of a basic circle, producing either epitrochoids or hypotrochoids, respectively. Both types of trochoids can be used either as a cylinder or piston form, so that four types of trochoidal machines can be designed (Figure 53).

In each case, the counterpart of the trochoid member always has one apex more than the trochoid itself. In the case of a trochoidal cylinder, the apexes of the piston show slipping along the inner cylinder surface; for trochoidal piston design, the piston shows a gear-like motion. As seen in Figure 53, a built-in compression pressure ratio disqualifies many configurations as valid concepts for

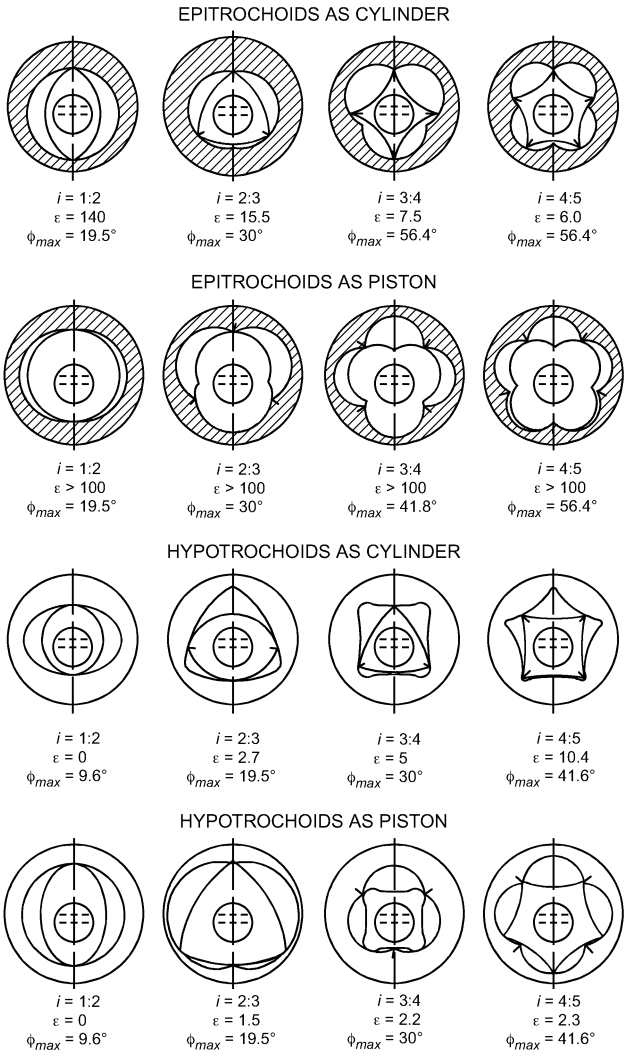


Fig. 53 Possible Versions of Epitrochoidal and Hypotrochoidal Machines

refrigeration compressor design. Because of additional valve ports, clearances, etc., and the resulting decrease in the built-in maximum theoretical compression ratio, only the first two types with epitrochoidal cylinders, and all candidates with epitrochoidal pistons, can be used for compressor technology. The latter, however, requires sealing elements on the cylinder as well as on the side plates, which does not allow the design of a closed sealing borderline.

In the past, trochoidal machines were designed much like those of today. However, like other positive-displacement rotary concepts that could not tolerate high internal oil circulation, early trochoidal compressors failed because of sealing problems. Wankel's invention of a closed sealing border changed this (Figure 54). Today, Wankel trochoidal compressors with a three-sided epitrochoidal piston (motor) and two-envelope cylinder (casing) are built in capacities of up to 7 kW.

Description and Performance

Compared to other compressors of similar capacity, trochoidal compressors have many advantages typical of reciprocating compressors. Because of the closed sealing border of the compression space, these compressors do not require extremely small, expensive manufacturing tolerances; neither do they need oil for sealing, keeping them at low-pressure side with the advantage of low solubility and high viscosity of the oil-refrigerant mixture. Valves are usually used on a high-pressure side while suction is ported. A valveless trochoidal compressor can also be built.

Wankel compressor performance compares favorably with the reciprocating piston compressors at a higher speed and moderate pressure ratio range. A smaller number of moving parts, less friction, and resulting higher mechanical efficiency improve overall isentropic efficiency. This can be observed at higher speed when sealing is better, and in the moderate pressure ratio range when the influence of the clearance volume is limited.

3.6 ROTATING SPOOL COMPRESSORS

The rotating spool compressor was first introduced by Kemp et al. in 2008. It is a rotary compressor mechanism, most similar to the sliding vane compressor. Three primary differences from a sliding vane compressor can be identified, as shown in Figures 54 and 55:

- The vane is constrained by means of an eccentric cam, allowing its distal end to be held in very close proximity to the housing bore while never contacting the bore.
- The rotor has affixed endplates that rotate with the central hub and vane, forming a rotating spool.
- Dynamic sealing elements are used to minimize leakage between the suction and compression pockets as well as between the process pockets and the compressor containment.

The movement of the rotor is purely rotary with only the vane and tip seals performing any oscillating movement. The eccentric cam forces the vane movement to oscillate by twice the eccentricity during a single rotation. The tip seals oscillate relative to the vane two times per rotation by an amount proportional to the ratio of diameters of the rotor to the rotor housing bore diameter. The tip seal movement amount is roughly an order of magnitude smaller than the eccentricity and follows a sinusoidal path. Analytical details regarding the geometry, including the mathematical expressions describing the chamber volumes, are presented in Bradshaw and Groll (2013).

Spool Compressor Attributes

Traditional vane machines (either sliding or rotary vane) are relatively difficult platforms to scale into larger capacity ranges (larger displacement). This problem stems from the interface between the vane and the housing bore and/or the interface between the vane and the end walls of the machine. The spool compressor mechanism reduces these problems by constraining the vane at the center of rotation and also rotating the end plate with the vane and rotor.

By constraining the vane close to its center of mass, the sliding velocity and kinematic forces are kept at a minimum. In addition, the vane itself is restricted from sliding on the housing bore. Instead, a secondary sealing element, the tip seal, is required to take up the gap between the end of the vane and the housing bore. Tip seal size and mass can be configured to reduce the frictional losses due to the contact between the housing bore and tip seal.

Additionally, the rotation of the end plates of the spool compressor mechanism greatly reduces the friction generated by the vane. Vane friction is not completely eliminated because the vane must slide radially relative to the end plate by an amount equal to the eccentricity. Since the end plate is rotating relative to the compressor housing, the gap between these two parts requires sealing. This is accomplished with an additional dynamic sealing element called the **spool seal**. Together these dynamic sealing elements give the spool compressor the flexibility to scale to sizes difficult for other vane technologies.

The spool compressor has also been explored for vapor injection and waste heat recovery applications. Mathison et al. (2013) investigated the trade-off in the placement and operation of a vapor injection port in the spool compressor. Krishna et al. (2014) explored

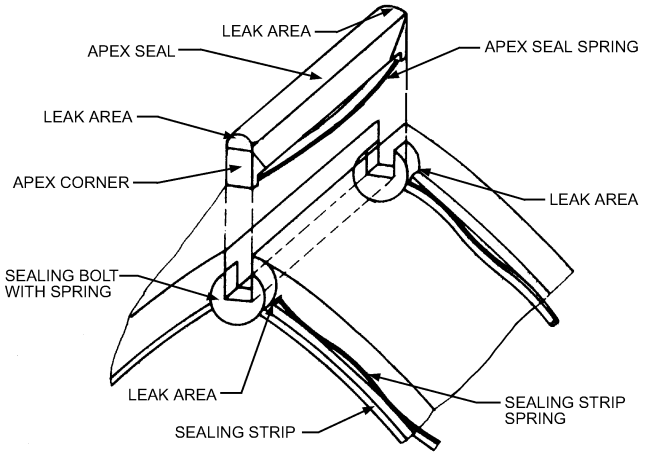


Fig. 54 Wankel Sealing System for Trochoidal Compressors

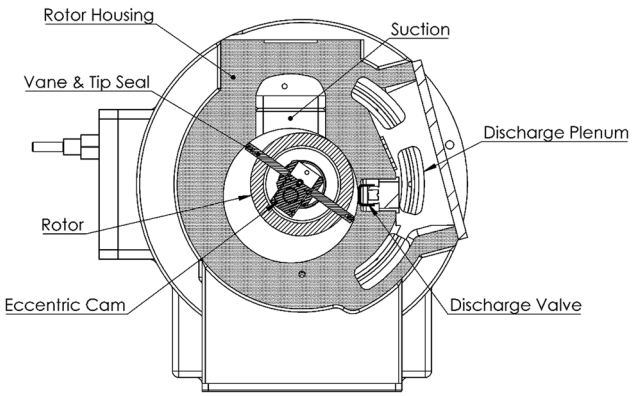


Fig. 55 Axial Cutaway of Semi-Hermetic Rotating Spool Compressor Showing Eccentric Cam and Vane Assemblies
(Courtesy of Torad Inc.)

using the spool mechanism as an expander in a 50 kW organic Rankine cycle (ORC) application.

Development Status and Performance

The spool compressor is a relatively young technology that has been demonstrated in the laboratory at capacities ranging from 18 to 141 kW for air-conditioning applications with refrigerants R-134a, R-410A, and R-1234ze(E). These demonstrations were on laboratory prototypes that were either open-drive or semi-hermetic. Efficiencies demonstrated in the laboratory are similar to legacy technologies such as scroll and screw compressors (Orosz et al. 2012, 2016, 2022).

4. CENTRIFUGAL COMPRESSORS

Centrifugal compressors, sometimes called turbocompressors, belong to a family of turbomachinery that includes fans, propellers, and turbines. These are classified as dynamic because they continuously exchange angular momentum between a rotating mechanical element and a steadily flowing fluid. For effective momentum exchange, their rotating speeds must be higher, but little vibration or wear results because of the steady motion and the absence of contacting parts such as pistons or vanes. Because their flows are continuous, turbomachines have greater volumetric capacities, size for size, than positive-displacement devices do.

Centrifugal compressors are used in a variety of refrigeration and air-conditioning installations. Suction flow ranges between 0.03 and 15 m^3/s, with rotational speeds between 1800 and 90 000 rpm. However, the high angular velocity associated with a low volumetric flow establishes a minimum practical capacity for most centrifugal applications. The upper capacity limit is determined by physical size, a 15 m^3/s compressor having a diameter of 1.8 to 2.1 m.

Centrifugal compressors are well-suited for air-conditioning and refrigeration applications because of their ability to produce a high pressure ratio. Suction flow enters the rotating element (impeller) axially, and is discharged radially at a higher velocity. The change in diameter through the impeller increases the gas velocity. This velocity (dynamic) pressure is then converted to static pressure through diffusion, which generally begins within the impeller and ends in a radial diffuser and volute outboard of the impeller.

Suction gas generally passes through a set of adjustable inlet guide vanes or an external suction damper before entering the impeller. These devices are used for capacity control.

High-velocity gas discharging from the impeller enters the radial diffuser, which can be vaned or vaneless. Vaned diffusers are typically used in compressors designed to produce high pressure. These vanes are generally fixed but can be adjustable. Adjustable diffuser vanes can be used for capacity modulation either in lieu of or in conjunction with the inlet guide vanes.

A centrifugal compressor can be single-stage, with only one impeller, or it can be multistage, with two or more impellers mounted in the same casing, as shown in Figure 57. For process refrigeration, a compressor can have as many as 10 stages.

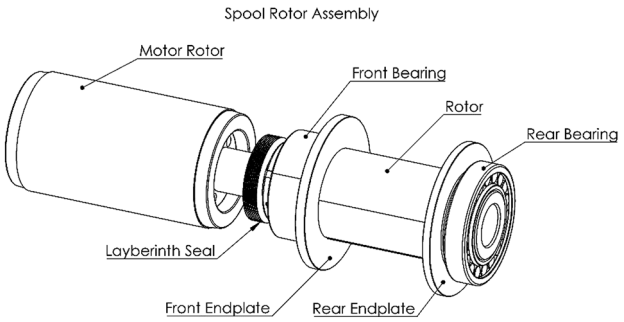


Fig. 56 Isometric View of Assembled Rotor and End Plates of a Spool Compressor
(Courtesy of Torad Inc.)

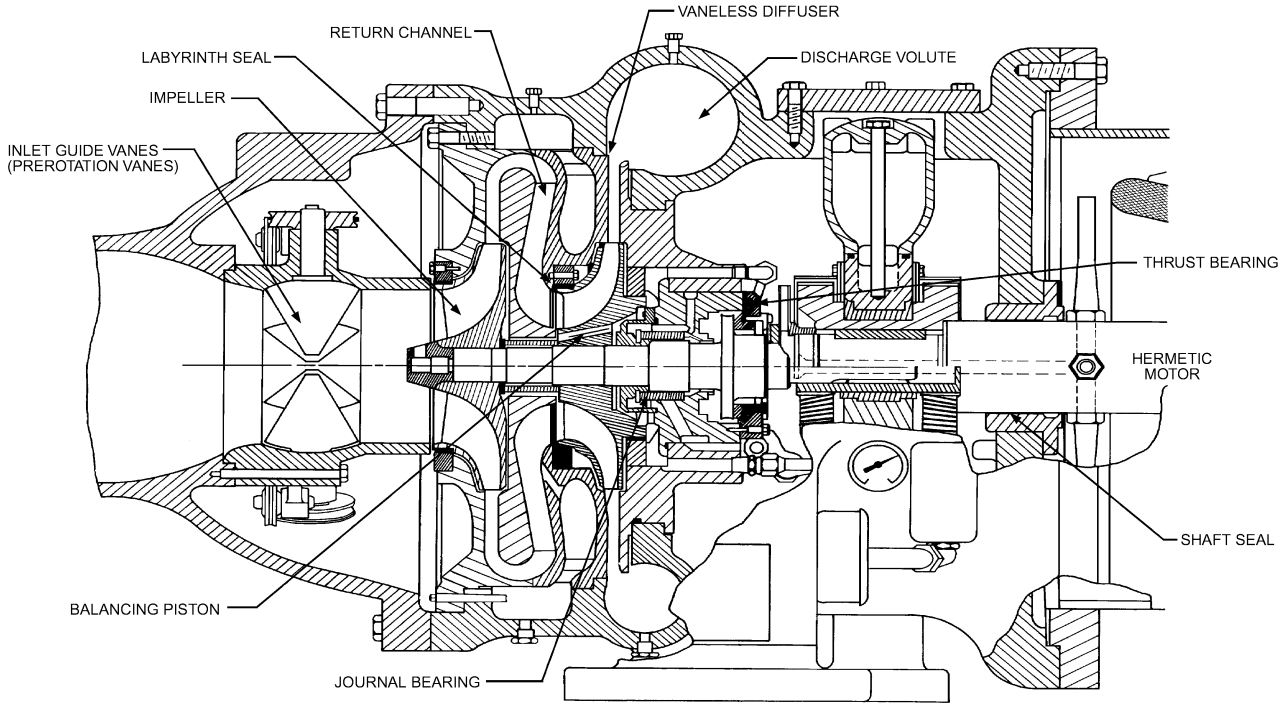


Fig. 57 Centrifugal Refrigeration Unit Cross Section

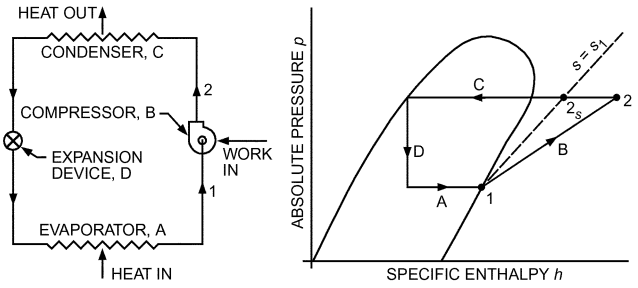


Fig. 58 Simple Vapor Compression Cycle

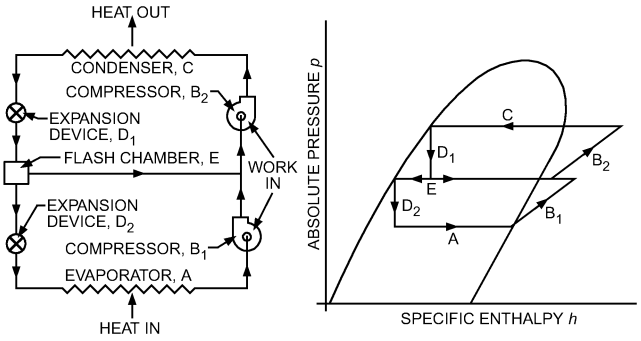


Fig. 59 Compression Cycle with Flash Cooling

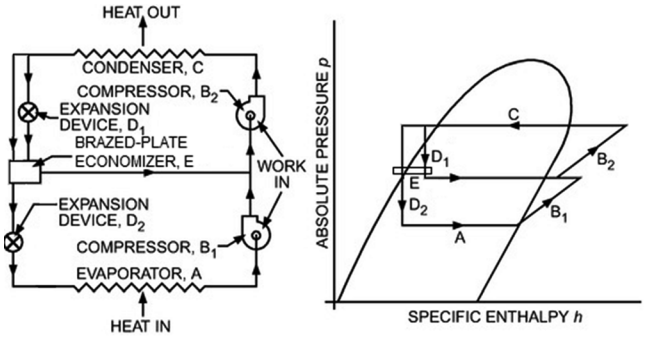


Fig. 60 Compression Cycle with Brazed-Plate Economizer

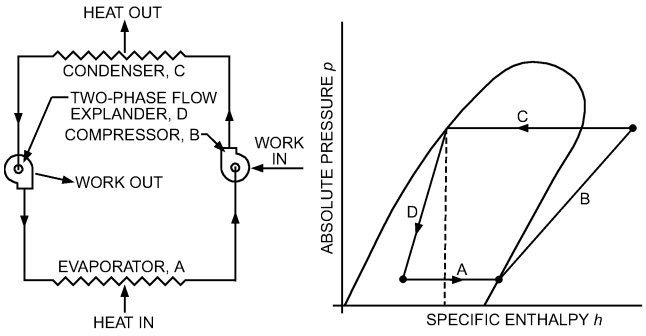


Fig. 61 Compression Cycle with Power Recovery Expander

In inline multistage compressors, gas discharged from the first stage is directed to the inlet of the second stage through a return channel. The return channel can contain a set of fixed-flow straightening vanes or an additional set of adjustable inlet guide vanes. Once the gas reaches the last stage, it is discharged from the impeller into a volute or collector chamber. From there, the high-pressure gas passes through the compressor discharge connection.

When multistage compressors are used, interstage gas flows can be introduced between stages so that one compressor performs several functions at several temperatures.

Refrigeration Cycle

Typical applications might involve a single-, two-, or three-stage halocarbon compressor or a seven-stage ammonia compressor. Figure 58 illustrates a simple vapor compression cycle in which a centrifugal compressor operates between states 1 and 2.

Figure 59 shows a more complex cycle, with two stages of compression and interstage liquid flash cooling. This cycle has a higher coefficient of performance than the simple cycle and is frequently used with two- through four-stage halocarbon and hydrocarbon compressors. This **economized cycle** achieves interstage cooling using a flash tank, as shown. Figure 60 shows another cycle with two stages of compression: a brazed-plate economizer is used to subcool the main evaporator liquid flow with heat exchange to the two-phase intrastage flow. A brazed-plate economizer, if 100% efficient, would provide the same cycle benefit as the flash tank.

Figure 61 shows a vapor compression cycle in which the expansion device is replaced by a power-recovering two-phase-flow turbine. The power recovered by the turbine is used to reduce the required compressor input work (Brasz 1995). Although not commonly applied on commercial centrifugals, power recovery during expansion reduces the enthalpy of the two-phase-flow mixture, thus increasing the refrigeration effect of this cycle.

More than one stage of flash cooling can be applied to compressors with more than two impellers (i.e., more than one stage). Liquid subcooling and interstage desuperheating can also be advantageously used. For more information on refrigeration cycles, see Chapter 2 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Angular Momentum

The momentum exchange, or energy transfer, between a centrifugal impeller and a flowing refrigerant is expressed by

$$W_i = u_i c_u \tag{14}$$

where

W_i = impeller work input per unit mass of refrigerant, J/kg
u_i = impeller blade tip speed, m/s
c_u = tangential component of refrigerant velocity leaving impeller blades, m/s

These velocities are shown in Figure 62, where refrigerant flows out from between the impeller blades with relative velocity b and absolute velocity c. The relative velocity angle β is a few degrees less than the blade angle because of a phenomenon known as slip.

Equation (14) assumes that refrigerant enters the impeller without any tangential velocity component or swirl. This is generally the case at design flow conditions. If the incoming refrigerant were already swirling in the direction of rotation, the impeller's ability to impart angular momentum to the flow would be reduced. A subtractive term would then be required in the equation. Likewise, flow swirling in the direction opposite rotation would theoretically yield a positive effect on the angular momentum imparted. Equation (15) shows the introduction of this subtractive term, and Figure 63 shows these additional velocities.

$$W_i = u_i c_u - u_1 c_{u1} \tag{15}$$

where

U_1 = impeller inlet root mean squared (RMS) blade speed at R_{rms}, m/s
c_{u1} = RMS tangential component of refrigerant velocity entering impeller blades at R_{rms}, m/s, where
R_{rms} = impeller inlet RMS radius, cm

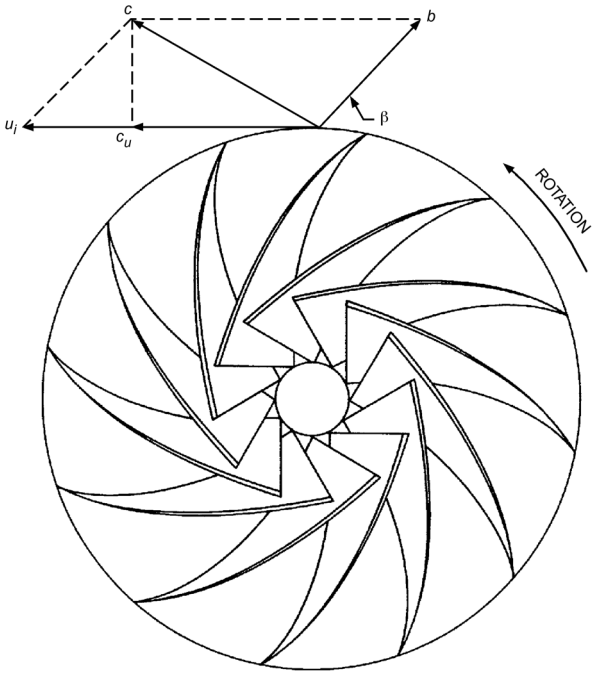


Fig. 62 Impeller Exit Velocity Diagram

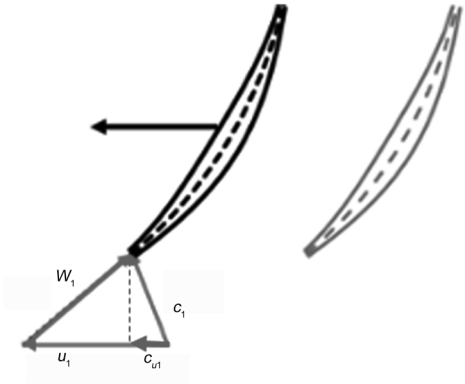


Fig. 63 Impeller Inlet Velocity Diagram

$= \sqrt{(R_{hub}^2 + R_{shroud}^2)/2}$, where

R_{hub} = impeller inlet hub radius, cm

R_{shroud} = impeller inlet shroud radius, cm

Some of the work done by the impeller increases refrigerant pressure; the remainder only increases its kinetic energy. The ratio of pressure-producing work to total work is known as the impeller reaction. Because this varies from about 0.4 to about 0.7, an appreciable amount of kinetic energy leaves the impeller with magnitude $c^2/2$.

To convert this kinetic energy into additional pressure, a diffuser is located after the impeller. Radial vaneless diffusers are most common, but vaned, pipe, volute, scroll, or conical diffusers are also used. To increase pressure recovery, add stage exist components downstream of the diffuser, using the return channel (intermediate stage) or the volute and scroll (last stage).

In an inline multistage compressor, flow leaving the first diffuser is guided to the inlet of the second impeller via an internal return channel, as shown in Figure 57, or external interstage piping if the stages are separated by a motor section. The total compression work input per unit mass of refrigerant is the sum of the individual stage inputs:

$$W = \sum W_i \tag{16}$$

provided mass flow rate is constant throughout the compressor.

Nondimensional Coefficients

Flow Coefficient. Desirable impeller diameters and rotational speeds are determined from blade tip velocity by a dimensionless flow coefficient Q/ND^3, in which Q is the volumetric flow rate. Practical values range from 0.02 to 0.35, with good performance between 0.11 and 0.21 and optimum results between 0.15 and 0.18. Impeller diameter D_i and rotational speed N follow from

$$Q/ND^3 = \pi Q_i/u_i D_i^2 = \pi^3 Q_i N^2/u_i^3 \tag{17}$$

where u_i is tip speed.

The maximum flow coefficient in multistage compressors is found in the first stage and the minimum in the last stage (unless large side loads are involved). For high pressure ratios, special measures may be necessary to increase the last-stage Q/ND^3 to a practical level, as stated previously. Side loads are beneficial in this respect, but interstage flash cooling is not.

Polytropic Work Coefficient. Besides the power requirement, polytropic work also determines impeller blade tip speed and number of stages. For an individual stage, stage work is related to speed by

$$W_{pi} = \mu_i u_i^2 \tag{18}$$

where μ_i is the stage work coefficient.

The overall polytropic work is the sum of the stage works:

$$W_p = \sum W_{pi} \tag{19}$$

and the overall work coefficient is

$$\mu = W_p/\sum u_i^2 \tag{20}$$

Values for μ and μ_i range from about 0.42 to about 0.74, with 0.55 representative for estimating purposes. Compressors designed for modest work coefficients have backward-curved impeller blades. These impellers tend to have greater part-load ranges and higher efficiencies than do radial-bladed designs.

Maximum tip speeds are limited by strength considerations to about 430 m/s. For cost and reliability, 300 m/s is a more common limitation. On this basis, the maximum polytropic work capability of a typical stage is about 45 kJ/kg.

A greater restriction on stage work capability is often imposed by the impeller Mach number M_i. For adequate performance, M_i must be limited to about 1.8 for stages with impellers overhung from the ends of shafts and to about 1.5 for impellers with shafts passing through their inlets because flow passage geometries are moved out. For good performance, these values must be even lower. Such considerations limit maximum stage work to about $1.5a_i^2$, where a_i is the acoustic velocity at the stage inlet.

A compressor user with a particular installation in mind may prefer more explicit curves, such as pressure ratio and power versus volumetric flow at constant rotational speed. Plots of this sort may require fixed suction conditions to be entirely accurate, especially if discharge pressure and power are plotted against mass flow or refrigeration effect.

Specific Speed. This nondimensional index of optimum performance characteristic of geometrically similar stages is defined by

$$N_s = N\sqrt{Q_i}/W_{pi}^{0.75} = (1/\pi^3\mu_i^{0.75})\sqrt{Q_i/ND_i^3} \quad (21)$$

Optimal dimensionless specific speed is 1.0 for maximum efficiency, as shown in Figure 64.

Mach Number

Two different Mach numbers are used. The flow Mach number M is the ratio of flow velocity c to acoustic velocity a at a particular point in the fluid stream:

$$M = c/a \quad (22)$$

where

$$a = v\sqrt{-(\partial p/\partial v)_s} = \sqrt{n_s pv} \quad (23)$$

The flow Mach number in a typical compressor varies from about 0.3 at the stage inlet and outlet to about 1.0 at the impeller exit. With increasing flow Mach number, the losses increase because of separation, secondary flow, and shock waves.

The impeller Mach number M_i, which is a pseudo Mach number, is the ratio of impeller tip speed to acoustic velocity a_i at the stage inlet:

$$M_i = u_i/a_i \quad (24)$$

Performance

From an applications standpoint, the parameters Ω (for head) and Θ (for flow) are more useful than μ and Q/ND^3 (Sheets 1952):

$$\Omega = W_p/a_i^2 = \mu(\sum u_i^2/a_i^2) \quad (25)$$

where the head parameter Ω = Gravitational constant × Polytropic work input/(Acoustic velocity at impeller input)^2. This can be rephrased as Ω = Overall work coefficient ([Stage work coefficient]^2/[Acoustic velocity at impeller input]^2).

$$\Theta = Q_1/a_1 D_1^2 = (M_1/\pi)(Q_1/ND_1^3) \quad (26)$$

where the flow parameter Θ = Volumetric flow rate/Acoustic velocity × (Tangential component of refrigerant velocity leaving impeller blades)^2. This can be rephrased as Θ = (First-stage impeller Mach number/π)(Volumetric flow rate/Rotational speed × Tangential component of refrigerant velocity leaving impeller blades)^3.

Both flow parameter Ω and head parameter Θ are critical to calculating overall turbocompressor performance. The related approaches here can be used as a check.

Performance is typically represented with compressor maps providing nondimensional flow on the x axis and nondimensional pressure rise on the y axis. Typical compressor maps for fixed- and variable-speed compressors are shown in Figures 65 and 66.

Figure 65 shows the map with a compressor using inlet guide vane to unload. The percentages associated with the solid lines indicate vane position relative to fully open. Percentages with dotted lines indicate aerodynamic efficiency- relative to peak.

Figure 66 shows the same map, but with a variable-speed compressor as the unloading mechanism instead of inlet guide vanes. The percentages by the solid lines here indicate percent impeller speed relative to full-load speed; those with dashed lines still indicate aerodynamic efficiency relative to peak. Note that the impeller/compressor in Figure 66 was designed from an aerodynamic standpoint to be at peak efficiency at ~70% of design speed, versus the

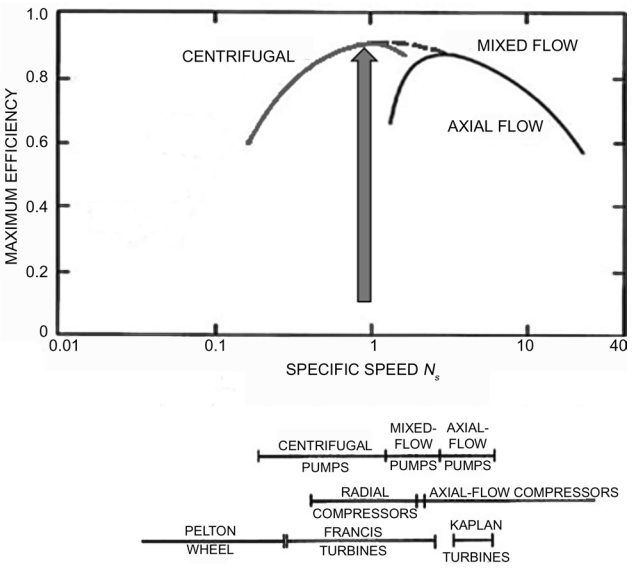


Fig. 64 Optimal Specific Speed

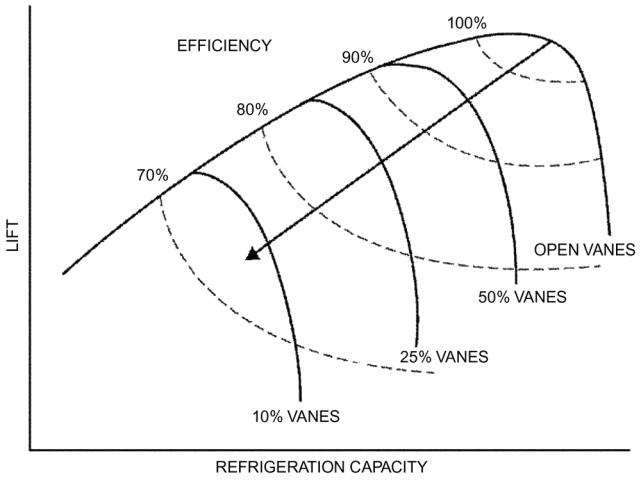


Fig. 65 Typical Constant-Speed Centrifugal Compressor Performance

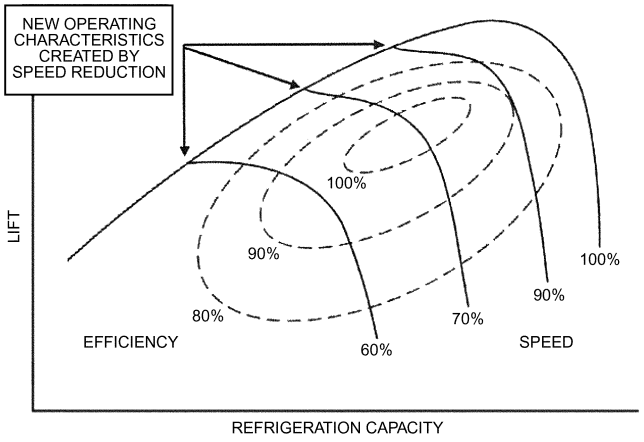


Fig. 66 Typical Variable-Speed Centrifugal Compressor Performance

constant speed in Figure 65 optimized for full-load operating points. This optimization is a design choice depending on application characteristics and product strategy.

A typical compressor performance map is shown in Figure 67, where percent of rated work is plotted with efficiency contours against percent of rated volumetric flow at various speeds. Point A is the design point at which the compressor operates with maximum efficiency. Point B is the selection or rating point at which the compressor is being applied to a particular system. From the application or user's point of view, Ω and Θ have their 100% values at point B.

Surging

Part-load range is limited (on the left side of the performance map) by a **surge envelope**. Satisfactory compressor operation to the left of this line is prevented by unstable **surging** or **hunting**, in which refrigerant alternately flows backward and forward through the compressor, accompanied by increased noise, vibration, and heat. Prolonged operation under these conditions can damage the compressor.

Flow reverses during surging about once every 2 s. Small systems surge at higher frequencies and large systems at lower. Surging can be distinguished from other kinds of noise and vibration by the fact that its flow reversals alternately unload and load the driver. Motor current varies markedly during surging, and turbines alternately speed up and slow down.

Another kind of instability, **rotating stall**, may occur slightly to the right of the true surge envelope. This phenomenon forms rotating stall pockets or cells in the diffuser. It produces a roaring noise at a frequency determined by the number of cells formed and the impeller running speed. Driver load is steady during rotating stall, which is harmless to the compressor, but may vibrate components excessively.

System Balance and Capacity Control

In a centrifugal compressor, system balance is achieved through compressor capacity control. The method of capacity control selected depends on the intended refrigeration system characteristic for the application and the associated economics of the various control strategies. Capacity control methods affect the compressor operating map, including head capability surge point and resulting efficiency at a given capacity, which must be considered when selecting the appropriate method for an application.

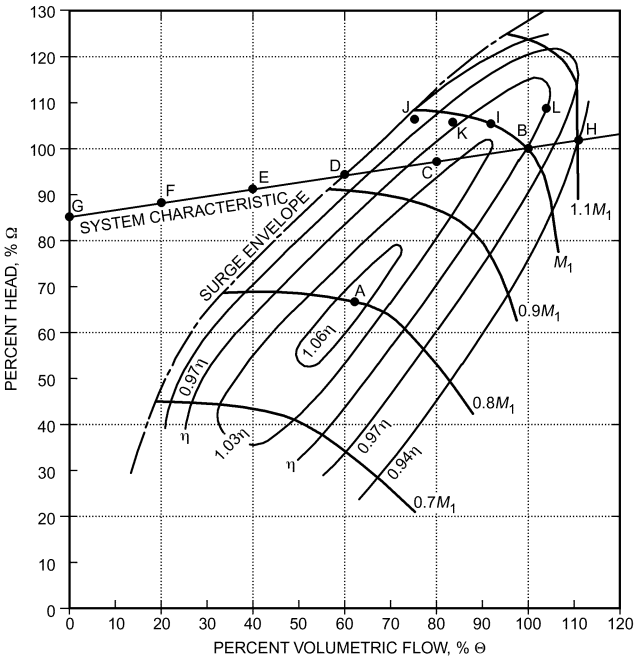


Fig. 67 Typical Compressor Performance Curves

Refrigeration and volumetric capacity are directly related to compressor speed, but the compressor's ability to produce pressure is also a function of the square of a change in compressor speed. For example, operating at half of a given compressor speed results in half the given volumetric capacity and one-quarter the given pressure ratio. Variable-speed control requires a system characteristic of decreasing isentropic or polytropic work (pressure difference) with decreasing flow (capacity) to perform more efficiently. Reducing condensing pressure generally decreases isentropic or polytropic work. Impeller tip speed must remain constant if lift requirements do not change; in other words, there is very little compressor efficiency benefit with decreasing capacity requirement if there is not a corresponding decrease in the polytropic work (pressure difference) requirement, because the compressor tip speed must be maintained.

Methods of capacity control include speed variation, prerotation vanes, suction throttling, adjustable diffuser vanes, movable diffuser walls, impeller throttling sleeves, staged flow recirculation, and combinations of these, such as prerotation vanes with variable speed. Each method has advantages and disadvantages in terms of performance, complexity, and cost that should be carefully considered before deciding on a capacity control strategy. The most common capacity control methods use speed variation combined with prerotation vanes.

Speed variation modulates capacity by adjusting the compressor drive speed to match the system characteristic. Speed variation is typically done by a variable-speed motor drive package, a turbine drive, or a generator-driven motor. Variable-speed motor drive packages are the most common method.

Figure 67 shows a centrifugal compressor performance map using speed variation to modulate capacity without prerotation vanes. In addition to the head and flow characteristic, it shows the speed and efficiency at which the compressor operates in that particular application. A refrigeration system characteristic for a typical brine cooling system curve has been overlaid on the map, passing through points B, C, D, E, F, G, and H. With increased speed, the compressor at point H produces more than its rated capacity; with decreased speeds at points C and D, it produces less. Because of surging, the compressor cannot be operated satisfactorily at points E, F, or G. The system can be operated at these capacities, however, by using additional unloading methods beyond the speed-only minimum unloading point. These additional methods, such as prerotation vanes, delay the speed-only unloading point at which the compressor goes into surge. This can be done in conjunction with hot-gas bypass to further extend into the surge points, but with an associated efficiency penalty. Volume flow at the compressor suction must be at least that for point D in Figure 67; this volume flow is reached by adding hot gas from the compressor discharge to the evaporator, or compressor suction piping. When hot-gas bypass is used, no further power reduction occurs as load decreases. The compressor is artificially loaded to stay out of the surge envelope. The increased volume caused by hot-gas recirculation performs no useful refrigeration.

Prerotation vanes (see Figure 57), also known as **inlet guide vanes (IGVs)**, modulate capacity by altering the direction of the fluid flow entering the impeller relative to the impeller blade leading edge. Setting the vanes to swirl flow in the direction of rotation produces a new compressor performance curve without any change in speed. Controlled positioning of the vanes can be done by pneumatically, electrically, or hydraulically. Frequently, IGVs are used for unloading in combination with variable speed. In this scenario, speed is used to unload the compressor until it approaches the surge

line (Figure 67, point D), and then the IGVs start to close for additional unloading.

Figure 68 shows a centrifugal compressor performance map at constant driver speed, using prerotation vanes to modulate capacity. Typical curves for five different vane positions are shown in Figure 68 for the compressor in Figure 67 at the constant speed M_1. In addition to the head and flow characteristic, it shows the prerotation vane position and efficiency at which the compressor operates in that particular application. With prerotation vanes wide open, the performance curve is identical to the M_1 curve in Figure 67. The other curves are different, as are the efficiency contours and the surge envelope. The same system characteristic has been superimposed on this performance map, as in Figure 67, to provide a comparison of these two modes of operation. In Figure 68, point E can be reached with prerotation vanes, but on the high-capacity end of the performance characteristic, point H cannot. Theoretically, turning the vanes against rotation would produce a performance line passing through point H, but sonic relative inlet velocities prevent this unless operating at low Mach numbers. Hot-gas bypass is still necessary at points F and G with prerotation vane control, but to a lesser extent than with variable speed. The operating characteristic differences of Figures 67 and 68 highlight the implications of these centrifugal compressor hardware choices, with higher speed for increased capacity and prerotation vanes for greater capacity turndown, depending on application requirements.

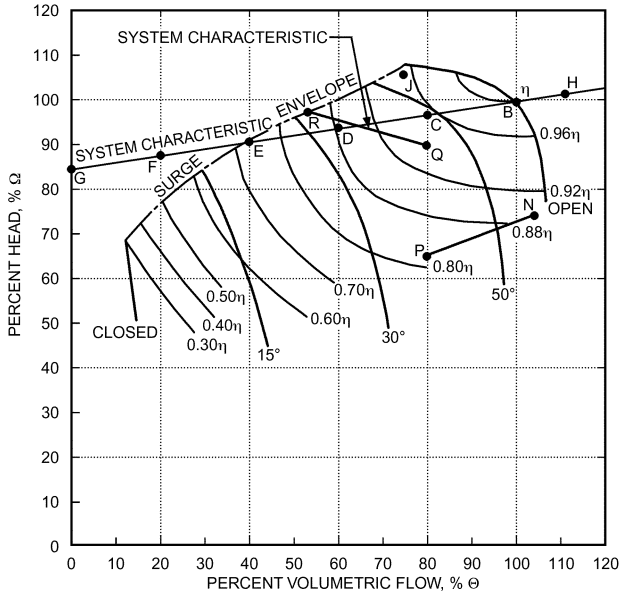


Fig. 68 Typical Compressor Performance with Various Prerotation Vane Settings

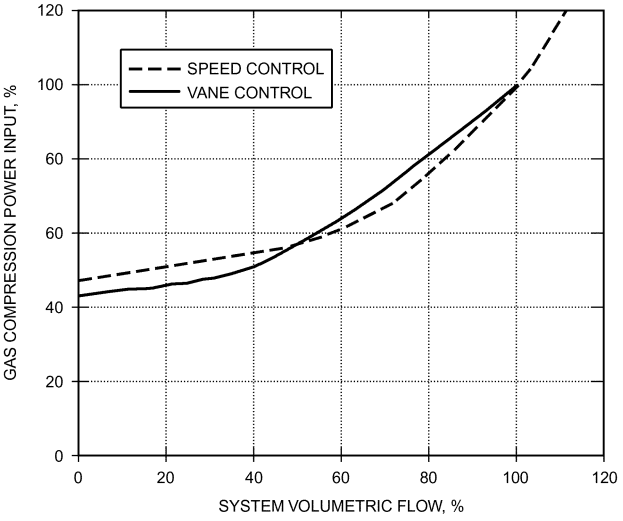


Fig. 69 Typical Part-Load Gas Compression Power Input for Speed and Vane Capacity Controls

Technology choices affect operating efficiency as well as operating range capability. Gas compression powers for both control methods are depicted in Figure 69. For the compressor and system assumed in this example, Figure 69 shows that speed control requires less gas compression power down to about 55% of rated capacity. Prerotation vane control requires less power below 55%. Complete analysis must also consider friction loss and driver efficiency. Typical losses in a variable-speed drive and motor combination increase the full-speed power consumption of the system by 2.0 to 3.5%.

In applications where pressure requirements do not vary significantly at part load, prerotation vanes alone are typically suitable. When pressure requirements vary at part load, variable speed can provide distinct operational and economic advantages. Variable speed is typically combined with prerotation vanes, operating with speed-only unloading until prerotation vane unloading becomes the more efficient mechanism and/or where hitting the surge line requires it. In either case, a thorough energy analysis should be performed for the specific application to ensure that the selected capacity control method and system balance most economically and efficiently meet the application requirements.

4.1 APPLICATION

Vibration

Excessive vibration of a centrifugal compressor indicates malfunction, which may lead to failure. Periodic checking or continuous monitoring of the vibration spectrum at suitable locations is, therefore, useful in ascertaining the operational health of the machine. The relationship between internal displacements and stresses and external vibration is different for each compressor design. In a given design, this relationship also differs for the various causes of internal displacements and stresses, such as imbalance of rotating parts (either inherent or caused by deposits, erosion, corrosion, looseness, or thermal distortion), bearing instability, misalignment, distortion because of piping loads, broken motor rotor bars, or cracked impeller blades. It is, therefore, impossible to establish universal rules for the level of vibration considered excessive.

To establish meaningful criteria for a given machine or design, it is necessary to have baseline data representing proper operation. Significant increases of any frequency component of the vibration spectrum above the baseline then indicate a deterioration in the machine's operation; the frequency component for which this increase occurs is a good indication of the part of the machine deteriorating. Increases in the component at the fundamental running frequency, for instance, are often because of balance deterioration. Increases at approximately one-half the fundamental running frequency are caused by fluid-film bearing instability, and increases at twice the running frequency usually result from deterioration of alignment, particularly coupling alignment. Electrically induced vibration is typically at twice the fundamental frequency (e.g., 120 Hz for a 60 Hz line frequency).

The equipment designer should set appropriate vibration limits, specified in terms of velocity, acceleration, or displacement. Acceptable limits will be unique to the size, arrangement, and

design of the equipment. Although measuring vibration amplitude on the bearing housing is convenient, the value of such measurements is limited because the stiffness of the bearing housing in typical centrifugal compressors is generally considerably larger than that of the oil film. Thus, vibration monitoring systems often use noncontacting sensors, which measure displacement of the shaft relative to the bearing housing, either instead of, or in addition to, monitoring bearing housing vibration (Mitchell 1977). Such sensors are also useful for monitoring axial displacement of the shaft relative to the thrust bearing.

In some applications, compressor vibration, which is perfectly acceptable from a reliability standpoint, can cause noise problems if the machine is not properly isolated from the building. Vibration tests of the installed machine under operating conditions give a base comparison for future reference.

Noise

Satisfactory application of centrifugal compressors requires careful consideration of noise control, especially if compressors are located near a noise-sensitive area of a building. The noise of centrifugal compressors is primarily of aerodynamic origin, principally gas pulsations associated with the impeller frequency and gas flow noise. Most predominant noise sources are of a high enough frequency (above 1000 Hz) that noise can be significantly reduced by carefully designed acoustical and structural isolation of the machine. Although the noise originates within the compressor proper, most is usually radiated from the discharge line and condenser shell. Equipment room noise can be reduced by up to 10 dB by covering the discharge line and condenser shell with acoustical insulation. In geared compressors, gear-mesh noise may also contribute to high-frequency noise; however, these frequencies are often above the audible range. This noise can be reduced by applying sound insulation material to the gear housing.

There are two important aspects in noise considerations for centrifugal compressors applications. In the equipment room, OSHA regulations specify employer responsibilities with regard to exposure to high sound levels. Increasing liability concerns are making designers more aware of compressor sound level considerations. Another important consideration is noise travel beyond the immediate equipment room.

Noise problems with centrifugal refrigeration equipment can occur in noise-sensitive parts of the building, such as a nearby office or conference room. The cost of controlling compressor noise transmission to such areas should be considered in building layout and weighed against cost factors for alternative locations of the equipment in the building.

If the equipment room is close to noise-sensitive building areas, it is usually cost-effective to have noise and vibration isolation designed by an experienced acoustical consultant, because small errors in design or execution can make the results unsatisfactory (Hoover 1960).

Blazier (1972) covers general information on typical noise levels near centrifugal refrigeration machines. Schaffer (2005) is another available source. Data on the noise output of a specific machine should be obtained from the manufacturer; the request should specify that measurements be in accordance with the current edition of AHRI *Standard* 575.

Drivers

Centrifugal compressors are driven by almost any prime mover: a motor, turbine, or engine. Power requirements range from 25 to 9000 kW, and driver selection must be compatible with compressor design speed. The driver is coupled to the compressor either directly or through a gear set to achieve the desired speed. Higher speeds can be achieved with a variable-speed drive. Flexible couplings are required to accommodate the angular, axial, and lateral misalignments that may arise in a drive train. Additional information on prime movers may be found in Chapters 7 and 45.

Centrifugal refrigeration compressors are used in many special applications. These units use single-, two-, and three-stage compressors driven by open and hermetic motors. These designs have internal gears and direct drives, both of which are quieter, less costly, and more compact than external gearboxes. Internal gears or high-speed, variable-frequency-driven motors may be used when compressors operate at speeds higher than two-pole motor synchronous speed. Chapter 43 discusses centrifugal water-chilling systems in greater detail.

A hermetic compressor absorbs motor heat because the motor is cooled by the refrigerant. An open motor is cooled by air in the equipment room; heat rejected by a hermetic motor must be considered in the refrigeration system design. Heat from an open motor must usually be removed from the equipment room, generally by mechanical ventilation. Because they operate at a lower temperature, hermetic motors are usually smaller than open motors for a given power rating. If a motor burns out, a hermetic system will require thorough cleaning, whereas an open motor will not. When serviced or replaced, an open motor must be carefully aligned to ensure reliable performance.

Starting torque must be considered in selecting a driver, particularly a motor or single-shaft gas turbine. Compressor torque is roughly proportional both to speed squared and to refrigerant density. The latter is often much higher at start-up than at rated operating conditions. If prerotation vanes or suction throttling cannot provide sufficient torque reduction for starting, the standby pressure must be lowered by some auxiliary means.

In certain applications, a centrifugal compressor drives its prime mover backward at shutdown. The compressor is driven backward by refrigerant equalizing through the machine. The extent to which reverse rotation occurs depends on the kinetic energy of the drive train relative to the expansive energy in the system. Large installations with dense refrigerants are most susceptible to running backward, a modest amount of which is harmless if suitable provisions have been made. Reverse rotation can be minimized or eliminated by closing discharge valves, side-load valves, and prerotation vanes at shutdown and opening hot-gas bypass valves and liquid refrigerant drains.

Paralleling

Problems associated with paralleling turbine-driven centrifugal compressors at reduced load are illustrated by points I and J in Figure 68. These represent two identical compressors connected to common suction and discharge headers and driven by identical turbines. A single controller sends a common signal to both turbine governors so that both compressors should be operating at part-load point K (full load is at point L). The I machine runs 1% faster than its twin because of their respective governor adjustments, whereas the J compressor works against 1% more pressure difference because of the piping arrangement. The result is a 20% discrepancy between the two compressor loads.

One remedy is to readjust the turbine governors so that the J compressor runs 0.5% faster than the other unit. A more permanent solution, however, is to eliminate one of the common headers and to provide either separate evaporators or separate condensers. This increases the compression ratio of whichever machine has the greater capacity, decreases the compression ratio of the other, and shifts both toward point K.

The problem of imbalance, associated with turbine-driven centrifugal compressors, is minimal in fixed-speed compressors with vane controls. A loading discrepancy comparable to this example would require a 25% difference in vane positions.

Paralleling centrifugal compressors offers advantages in redundancy and improved part-load operation. This arrangement provides the capability of efficiently unloading to a lower percentage of total load. When the unit requirement reduces to 50%, one compressor can carry the complete load and operates at a higher percent volumetric flow and efficiency than a single large compressor.

Providing a way to prevent refrigeration flow through the idle compressor to prevent inadvertent flow of hot-gas bypass through the compressor is necessary. In addition, isolation valves should be provided on each compressor to allow removal or repair of either compressor.

Other Specialized Applications

Centrifugal compressors are used in petroleum refineries, marine refrigeration, and in the chemical industry, as covered in Chapters 26 and 46 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*. Marine requirements are also detailed in ASHRAE *Standard* 26.

4.2 MECHANICAL DESIGN

Impellers

Impellers without covers are known as **open** or **unshrouded** designs. Open models have exposed blades, and the outermost edge of the impeller blade must operate close to a contoured stationary volute. This close tolerance minimizes excessive leakage past the blades from the higher-pressure area back to the lower-pressure area.

Those with covered blades (see Figure 57) are known as **shrouded impellers**, which are constructed with an integral contoured surface mechanically attached to the blade tips. Shrouded designs must be fitted with seals around their inlets to minimize passage of high-pressure gas back into the low-pressure side. Seals behind each stage are required in multistage compressors. Suction and interstage seals are typically of a labyrinth style, although contacting and toothed seals are also available.

Impellers must be firmly mounted to the compressors' driven shaft. Interference fit, keyed, bolted, or clamping mechanisms are common securing options. This connection must be designed to prevent loosening caused by thermal and centrifugal expansions as well as any dynamic loads that may be generated by mechanical or electrical sources.

Generally, HVAC-application impellers are constructed of cast or machined aluminum. In other applications, cast, brazed, riveted, or welded steel are needed because of temperature requirements. Aluminum has a higher strength-mass ratio than steel, up to about 150°C, which allows higher rotating speeds with lighter rotors. Steel impellers retain their strength at higher temperatures and are more resistant to erosion. Alternative materials may be required in corrosive applications.

Casings

Centrifugal compressor casings form the body, connection points, and pressure boundary of the compressor. They are designed for the worst-case pressure requirement of the system and containment of fluids used in the system. To satisfy the listing requirements of a nationally recognized testing laboratory, a hydrostatic test pressure three times the working pressure is required.

Cast iron is the most common casing material. Nodular iron and cast or fabricated steel are also used for low temperatures, high pressures, high shock loads, and hazardous applications. With modern casting methods, aluminum has also become very popular for compressor casings. Industrial-style multistage casings are usually split horizontally, although unsplit barrel designs can also be used.

Rotor Dynamics

Centrifugal compressors must be designed so that the first lateral critical speed is either well above or well below the expected operating speed. Operation at a speed between 0.8 and 1.1 times the first lateral speed is generally unacceptable from a reliability standpoint. The second lateral critical speed should be at least 25% above the operating speed of the machine.

Manufacturers have full responsibility for making sure critical speeds are not too close to operating speeds. Operating speed depends on the required flow and lift of the application. Avoiding operation near a rotor's critical speed has become increasingly complex with the broader speed ranges encountered when using variable-frequency drives. Torsional critical speed must also be considered in the design of a compressor and drive system. This is usually not an issue with hermetic designs due to the compactness and relative torsional stiffness. However, in open-drive machines, it is also necessary to consider the compressor, driver, gears, and coupling(s). Manufacturers of centrifugal compressors use computer programs to calculate torsional natural frequencies of the entire system, including the driver, coupling(s), and gears, if any. Responsibility for performing this calculation and ascertaining that the torsional natural frequencies are sufficiently far away from torsional exciting frequencies should be shared between the compressor manufacturer and the system designer. For some drive systems, it may be desirable to use a fluid coupling to isolate the compressor (and gear set) from engine torque pulsations. Depending on compressor bearing design, there may be other speed ranges that should be avoided to prevent the nonsynchronous shaft vibration commonly called **oil whip** or **oil whirl**.

Lubrication

For simplicity, size, and cost, most air-conditioning and refrigeration compressors have internal bearings, as shown in Figure 57. Bearings may be lubricated with oil or refrigerant. Most commercial HVAC compressor systems use a separate lubrication system to provide clean, cooled, pressurized lubricant to the bearings. Some industrial compressors have internal oil pumps driven by the compressor shaft, and typically include an auxiliary oil pump for prelube, postlube, and back-up service.

The lubrication system for oil-lubricated bearings consists, at minimum, of an oil pump, oil filter, oil cooler, and safety controls. Oil filters are usually rated for particle sizes of 15 to 20 μm or less. They may be built into the compressor or may be externally mounted. Dual filters can be provided for industrial applications so that one can be serviced while the other is operating. Most refrigerants are soluble in lubricating oils, the extent increasing with refrigerant pressure and decreasing with oil temperature. A compressor's oil may typically contain 20% refrigerant (by mass) during idle periods of high pressure and 5% during normal operation. Thus, refrigerant will come out of solution and foam the oil when subjected to a pressure drop (e.g., during startup).

To prevent excessive foaming from cavitating the oil pump and starving the bearings, oil heaters minimize refrigerant solubility during idle periods. Standby oil temperatures between 55 and 65°C are typical, depending on pressure. Once a compressor starts, its oil should be cooled to increase oil viscosity and maximize refrigerant retention during pulldown.

A sharp reduction in pressure before starting tends to supersaturate the oil. This produces more foaming at start-up than would the same pressure reduction after the compressor has started. Machines designed for a pressure ratio of 20 or more may reduce pressure so rapidly that excessive oil foaming cannot be avoided, except by maintaining a low standby pressure. Additional information on refrigerant solubility in oil can be found in Chapters 1, 4, and 12 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

External bearings avoid the complications of refrigerant-oil solubility at the expense of some oil recovery problems. Any nonhermetic compressor must have at least one shaft seal. Mechanical seals are commonly used in refrigeration machines because they are leaktight during idle periods. These seals require some lubrication of the faces during operation and may have a small amount of oil leakage when operating. Shaft seals leak oil out of compressors with internal bearings and into compressors with external bearings. Means for recovering seal oil leakage with minimal refrigerant loss must be provided in external bearing systems.

Bearings

Centrifugal compressors use rolling element, gas, and magnetic bearings to support radial and thrust loads. Radial loads are a result of static weight of the rotating assembly, gear mesh separation forces (if so configured), and, to a much lesser extent, aerodynamic loads. Thrust loads are primarily the result of the pressure field behind an impeller exceeding the combined pressure and momentum forces acting on the impeller inlet. In multistage designs, each impeller adds to the total thrust. Thrust forces due to pressure differential can be mitigated by using a balance piston (see Figure 57) to minimize the high-pressure area, opposed impellers in the case of a multiple impellers, or helical gearsets designed to provide opposing thrust in a geared machine. To avoid axial rotor vibration, some net axial load must be retained on the rotating assembly. This can be achieved using preloaded bearings or careful consideration of the thrust characteristics over the machine operating range. Regardless of the bearing system chosen, the bearings' dynamic stiffness and dampening characteristics must be considered when determining compressor critical speeds, to ensure stable turbomachinery operation over the application range of speeds and pressures.

Bearing Systems. This section is not meant to be a full design guide on bearings and bearing design, but an introduction to types of bearings used successfully in centrifugal compressors.

Fluid-film bearings have no active or moving parts during rotation, but instead rely on a thin film of fluid to support the shaft in the bearing bore. During operation, there is no contact between the shaft and bearing bore, or sleeve. The simplest example is a hydrostatic journal bearing, which has a predominantly smooth bearing bore or sleeve, which allows oil flow into and out of the sleeve/shaft interface. Hydrostatic bearings require a lubrication pump to provide oil at a predesigned pressure. During operation, spinning of the shaft creates a film or oil wedge to help support the rotating member. Fluid film bearings can address both radial and axial thrust loads.

The most common example of **foil bearings** are the self-acting, compliant-surface (spring loaded) hydrodynamic bearings that use ambient air or process gas as the lubricant. They can be designed to carry radial or axial loads. Beyond HVAC, applications include turbochargers, generators, air cycle machines, and aircraft and automobile engines.

Foil bearing designs often consist of a top foil and bump foil. The top foil provides a scuff-resistant start/stop surface that captures gas and develops the film that supports the journal or axial thrust collar. The bump foil supports the top foil and can be tailored for the required bearing stiffness.

In a foil bearing, once the shaft is spinning fast enough, the working fluid is pulled into the bearing by viscosity effects. Accordingly, foil bearings require an adequate supply of lubricant to pressurize and cool the bearings, but they do not require an external, pressurized system to supply the working fluid. Once pressurized, the gas pushes the foil away from the shaft so there is no contact. A relatively high-speed shaft is required to initiate the vapor gap; once this has been achieved, no wear occurs.

A **rolling element bearing** is well represented by the common ball bearing used in many pieces of rotating mechanical equipment. At a minimum, a rolling element bearing must have a fixed outer race, a fixed inner race mated to the rotating member, and many individual rolling elements positioned between the two. Rolling elements are usually spherical or cylindrical; the latter may vary in aspect ratio (length to diameter) and also alignment or angle to the rotating element axial centerline. Rolling element bearings can be selected individually or in sets of differing styles, to control both radial and thrust loads.

Traditional rolling element bearings have used steel races and steel rollers. This is a well-documented and well-proved combination. Rolling element bearings require lubrication and cooling of the rolling interface. Lubrication can generally be supplied at a lower pressure than hydrostatic oil film bearings.

Hybrid ceramic rolling-element bearings are similar to steel rolling-element bearings except for material. Typical construction consists of high-quality stainless steel races and silicon nitride ceramic rollers. In application, they can be designed to carry radial or axial loads using ball and/or cylindrical rollers.

Compared to steel, ceramic rollers are less dense and have higher modulus of elasticity and lower thermal expansion coefficients and lower friction coefficients. The lower density leads to lower centrifugal forces, allowing higher operating speeds. The higher modulus of elasticity results in higher bearing stiffness and lower contact areas, which, coupled with lower friction coefficients, lead to lower friction losses compared to steel contact pairs. Low friction losses and the ability to function with viscosities significantly lower than oils allow use of pressurized, filtered and conditioned liquid refrigerant as a lubricant. The pressurized, filtered refrigerant lubricant must be supplied to the bearing to ensure no contact-zone flashing. To further reduce the chance of flashing, the bearing design must support low applied pressure drop through (and low temperature rise across) the bearing. An additional benefit of a hybrid ceramic bearing is that the ceramic elements provide electrical isolation between the rotating member and the surrounding case; this can be desirable in some applications.

Magnetic bearings use a combination of radial and axial bearings, position sensors, a bearing controller, and a bearing power source to levitate and align the shaft without physical contact. An example compressor system using magnetic bearings is shown in Figure 70.

Each radial bearing consists of a stationary electromagnetic armature and a series of laminations fixed to the compressor shaft. Thrust bearings typically consist of a set of electromagnetic armatures on either side of a single disc fixed to the shaft or on either end of features on the shaft. Position sensors near each bearing measure the location of the rotating shaft and transmit data to the bearing controller, which processes the information. The bearing controller sends a signal to the bearing power amplifier, which processes the information. The bearing controller sends a signal to the bearing power amplifier, which adjusts the magnetic field for each individual magnetic bearing to correct the shaft position. The shaft position is carefully adjusted thousands of times per second. Magnetic bearings do not require lubrication but must be cooled, which is typically done by refrigerant gas over the armatures inside the compressor and by ambient air over the power amplifiers.

Two different systems are typically used to power the magnetic bearing system in the case of a power failure. In some, a battery back-up system is used. In others, the motor becomes an electrical generator that keeps the bearing system powered until the compressor comes to a complete stop. In the motor regeneration system, capacitors in the variable-frequency-drive system also aid in storing enough energy to maintain control of the rotor during a power loss shutdown. Back-up (touchdown) bearings support the shaft while at rest and serve as additional protection in case of a magnetic bearing system failure.

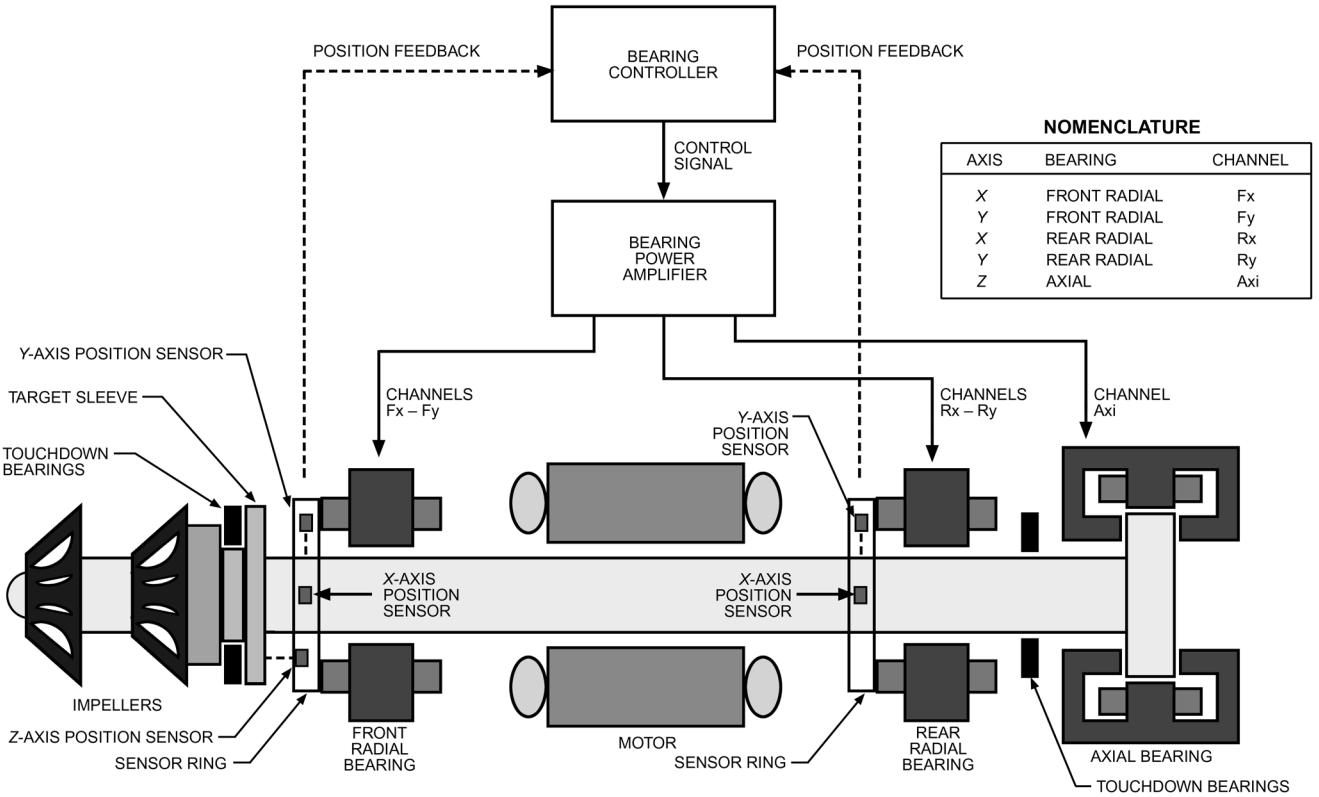


Fig. 70 Magnetic Bearing Schematic on Oil-Free Centrifugal Compressor
(Courtesy of Danfoss)

Axial bearings help manage axial (thrust) loads of the rotating members. Axial loads may be caused by gear mesh forces, motor electrical forces, or pressure imbalance on the impeller or impellers. All of the bearing styles discussed in this section may be configured to, or have counterparts to, provide axial load control.

Oil-Free Centrifugal Compressors

Oil-free compressors are enabled by foil, hybrid ceramic, and magnetic bearings. Oil-free compressors provide certain advantages to the chiller system designer, which can influence the cost, performance, and operational range of the chiller.

Accessories and Controls

The minimum accessories required by a centrifugal compressor with oil-lubricated bearings are an oil filter, oil cooler, and safety controls. Oil filters are usually rated for particle sizes of 15 to 20 µm or less. They may be built into the compressor but are more often externally mounted. Dual filters can be provided for industrial applications so that one can be serviced while the other is operating.

An oil cooler system may use condenser water, chilled water, refrigerant, or air as its cooling medium. Water- and refrigerant-cooled models may be built into the compressor, and refrigerant-cooled oil coolers may be built into a system heat exchanger. Many oil coolers are mounted externally for maximum serviceability.

Safety controls, with or without anticipatory alarms, must include a low-oil-pressure cutout switch and controls for high oil temperature and high discharge and low suction pressure (or temperature). A high-motor-temperature device is necessary in a hermetic compressor. Other common safety controls and alarms include sensing of discharge temperature, bearing temperature, oil filter pressure differential, oil level, low oil temperature, shaft seal pressure, balancing piston pressure, surging, vibration, and thrust bearing wear.

Pressure transducers and electrical temperature measurement devices (e.g., resistance temperature detectors [RTDs]) are useful indicators of critical items monitored by the controls. Suction, discharge, and oil differential pressure gages are the most important, followed by suction, discharge, and oil thermometers. Suction and discharge instruments are often attached to components rather than to the compressor itself, but they should be provided. Interstage pressures and temperatures can also be helpful, either on the compressor or on the system. Generally, all compressor controls are integrated into the overall unit control system. These sensors can be used not only to protect and monitor the equipment, but also integrated into system controls to allow the broadest operating range possible when conditions permit.

4.3 ISENTROPIC ANALYSIS

The static pressure resulting from a compressor's work input or, conversely, the amount of work required to produce a given pressure rise, depends on compressor efficiency and the thermodynamic properties of the refrigerant. For an adiabatic process, the work input required is minimal if compression is isentropic. Therefore, actual compression is often compared to an isentropic process, and performance thus evaluated is based on an isentropic analysis.

The reversible work required by an isentropic compression between states 1 and 2_s in Figure 56 is known as the **adiabatic work**, as measured by the enthalpy difference between the two points:

$$W_s = h_{2_s} - h_1 \tag{27}$$

Assuming negligible cooling occurs, the irreversible work done by the actual compressor is

$$W_s = h_2 - h_1 \tag{28}$$

Flash-cooled compressors cannot be analyzed by this procedure unless they are subdivided into uncooled segments with the cooling effects evaluated by other means. Compressors with side flows must also be subdivided. In Figure 59, the two compression processes must be analyzed individually. In this case, a mass-flow weighted average of the stage efficiencies can be used to compute an overall efficiency.

Equation (28) also assumes a negligible difference in kinetic energies of refrigerant at states 1 and 2 and an adiabatic process having no heat transfer. If the kinetic energy is not negligible, a kinetic energy term must be added to the equation. All thermodynamic properties discussed in this section are static properties as opposed to stagnation properties; the latter includes kinetic energy. It is possible to use total properties to calculate the same efficiency term and to neglect the kinetic energy change. In a normal vapor compression refrigeration cycle, high velocities leaving the compressor would be undesirable because of reduced pressure rise (or lost work). Hence, using total properties to calculate efficiencies is generally accepted.

The ratio of isentropic work to actual work is the **adiabatic efficiency**:

$$\eta_s = \frac{h_{2_s} - h_1}{h_2 - h_1} \tag{29}$$

This varies from about 0.62 to about 0.83, depending on the application. Because of the thermodynamic properties of gases, a compressor's overall adiabatic efficiency does not completely indicate its individual stage performance. The same compressor produces different adiabatic results with different refrigerants and with the same refrigerant at different suction conditions.

In spite of its shortcomings, isentropic analysis has a definite advantage in that adiabatic work can be read directly from thermodynamic tables and charts similar to those presented in Chapter 30 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Where these are unavailable for the particular gas or gas mixture, they can be accurately calculated and plotted using thermodynamic relationships.

4.4 POLYTROPIC ANALYSIS

Polytropic analysis is of benefit when multistage compressors are being evaluated. The computational effort is less, because the average stage efficiency can be applied to all stages.

The path equation for this reversible process is

$$\eta = v(dp/dh) \tag{30}$$

where η is the **polytropic efficiency** and v is the specific volume of the refrigerant. Reversible work done along the polytropic path is known as **polytropic work** and is given by

$$W_p = \int_{p_1}^{p_2} v\, dp \tag{31}$$

It follows from Equations (28), (30), and (31) that the polytropic efficiency is the ratio of reversible work to actual work:

$$\eta = \frac{W_p}{h_2 - h_1} \tag{32}$$

Equation (30) can be approximated using ideal gas assumptions by

$$\frac{p^m}{T} = \frac{p_1^m}{T_1} = \frac{p_2^m}{T_2} \tag{33}$$

$$pv^n = p_1 v_1^n = p_2 v_2^n \tag{34}$$

where

$$m = \frac{ZR}{c_p}\left(\frac{1}{\eta} + X\right) = \frac{(k - 1/k)(1/\eta + X)Y}{(1 + X)^2} \tag{35}$$

$$n = \frac{1}{Y - (ZR/c_p)(1/\eta + X)(1 + X)} = \frac{1 + X}{Y[(1/k)(1/\eta + X) - (1/\eta - 1)]} \tag{36}$$

and

$$X = \frac{T}{v}\left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial p}\right)_p - 1 \tag{37}$$

$$Y = -\frac{p}{v}\left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial p}\right)_T \tag{38}$$

$$Z = \frac{pv}{RT} \tag{39}$$

Also, R is the gas constant and k is the ratio of specific heats; all properties are at temperature T. These equations can be used to allow integration so that Equation (31) can be written as follows:

$$W_p = \frac{n}{(n-1)} p_1 v_1 \left[\left(\frac{p_2}{p_1}\right)^{(n-1)/n} - 1\right] \tag{40}$$

Further manipulation eliminates the exponent:

$$W_p = \left[\frac{p_2 v_2 - p_1 v_1}{\ln(p_2 v_2 / p_1 v_1)}\right] \ln\left(\frac{p_2}{p_1}\right) \tag{41}$$

For greater accuracy in handling gases with properties known to deviate substantially from those of a perfect gas, a more complex procedure is required. The accuracy with which Equations (33) and (34) represent Equation (30) depends on the constancy of m and n along the polytropic path. Because these exponents usually vary, mean values between states 1 and 2 should be used.

Compressibility functions X and Y have been generalized for gases in corresponding states by Schultz (1962) and their equivalents are listed by Edminster (1961). For usual conditions of refrigeration interest (i.e., for $p < 0.9p_c$, $T < 1.5T_c$, and $0.6 < Z$), these functions can be approximated by

$$X = 0.1846(8.36)^{1/Z} - 1.539 \tag{42}$$

$$Y = 0.074(6.65)^{1/Z} - 0.509 \tag{43}$$

Compressibility factor Z has been generalized by Edminster (1961) and Hougen et al. (1959), among others. Generalized corrections for specific heat at constant pressure c_p can also be found in these works.

Equations (33) and (34) make possible the integration of Equation (31):

$$W_p = f\left(\frac{n}{n-1}\right) p_1 v_1 \left[\left(\frac{p_2}{p_1}\right)^{(n-1)/n} - 1\right] \tag{44}$$

In Equation (44), polytropic work factor f corrects for whatever error may result from the approximate nature of Equations (33) and (34). Because the value of f is between 1.00 and 1.02 in most refrigeration applications, it is generally neglected.

Once the polytropic work has been found, efficiency follows from Equation (32). Polytropic efficiencies range from about 0.70 to about 0.84, a typical value being 0.76.

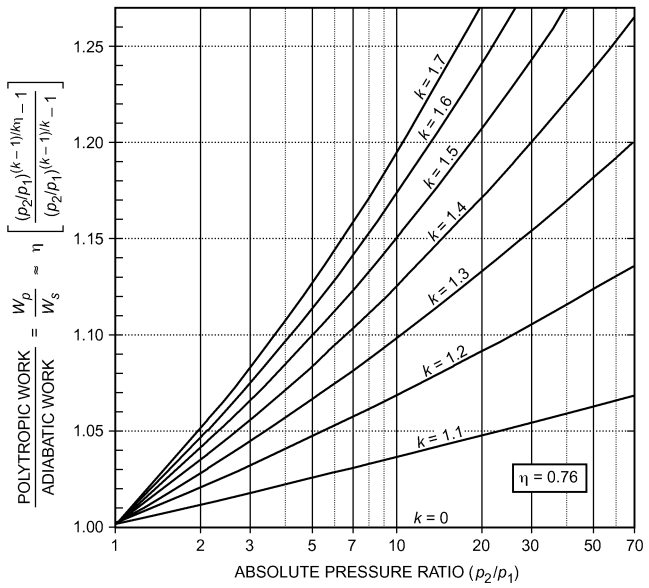


Fig. 71 Ratio of Polytropic to Adiabatic Work

The highest efficiencies are obtained with the largest compressors and densest refrigerants because of a Reynolds number effect discussed by Davis et al. (1951). A small number of stages is also advantageous because of parasitic loss associated with each stage.

Overall, polytropic work and efficiency are more consistent from one application to another because they represent an average stage aerodynamic performance.

Instead of using Equations (30) to (44), it is easier and often more desirable to determine the adiabatic work by isentropic analysis and then convert to polytropic work by

$$\frac{W_p}{W_s} \approx \eta \left[\frac{(p_2/p_1)^{(k-1)/k\eta} - 1}{(p_2/p_1)^{(k-1)/k} - 1} \right] \tag{45}$$

Equation (45) is strictly correct only for an ideal gas, but because it is a ratio involving comparable errors in both numerator and denominator, it is of more general utility. Equation (46) is plotted in Figure 69 for $\eta = 0.76$. To obtain maximum accuracy, the ratio of specific heats k must be a mean value for states 1, 2, and 2_s. If c_p is known, k can be determined by

$$k = \frac{1}{1 - (ZR/c_p)(1+X)^2/Y} \tag{46}$$

Gas compression power is

$$P = wW \tag{47}$$

where w is mass flow. To obtain total shaft power, add the mechanical friction loss. Friction loss varies from less than 1% of gas power to more than 10%. A typical estimate is 3% for compressor friction losses. Determining total power typically includes motor inefficiency and, if applicable, electrical loads for powered auxiliary systems (e.g., variable-frequency drive inefficiency, magnetic bearings, controls, power filtering). These loads are additive to total shaft power.

Testing

When a centrifugal compressor is tested, overall μ and η versus Q_1/ND_1^3 at constant M_1 are plotted. They are useful because test results with one gas are sometimes converted to field performance with another. When side flows and cooling are involved, the overall work coefficient is found from Equations (19) and (20) by evaluating mixing and cooling effects between stages separately. The **overall efficiency** in such cases is

$$\eta = \frac{\sum w_i W_{pi}}{\sum w_i W_i} \tag{48}$$

Testing with a fluid other than the design refrigerant is a common practice known as **equivalent performance testing**. Its need arises from the impracticability of providing test facilities for the complete range of refrigerants and input power for which centrifugal compressors are designed. Equivalent testing is possible because a given compressor produces the same μ and η at the same Q/ND^3 and M_i with any fluids whose volume ratios (v_1/v_2) and Reynolds numbers are the same.

Thermodynamic performance of a compressor can be evaluated according to either the stagnation or static properties of the refrigerant, and it is important to distinguish between these concepts. The **stagnation efficiency**, for example, may be higher than the **static efficiency**. The safest procedure is to use static properties and evaluate kinetic energy changes separately.

4.5 OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE

Refer to the compressor manufacturer's operating and maintenance instructions for recommended procedures. A planned maintenance program, as described in Chapter 40 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, should be established. As part of this program, operating documentation should be kept, tabulating pertinent unit temperatures, pressures, flows, fluid levels, electrical data, and refrigerant added. ASHRAE *Guideline* 4 has further information on documentation. These can be compared periodically with values recorded for the new unit. Gradual changes in data can signify the need for routine maintenance; abrupt changes indicate system or component difficulty. A successful maintenance program requires the operating engineer to recognize and identify the reason for these data trends. In addition, by knowing the component parts and their operational interaction, the designer can use these symptoms to prescribe proper maintenance procedures.

The following items deserve attention in establishing a planned compressor maintenance program:

- A tight system is important. Leaks on compressors operating at subatmospheric pressures allow noncondensables and moisture to enter the system, adversely affecting operation and component life. Leakage in higher-pressure systems allows oil and refrigerant loss. ASHRAE *Standard* 147 can be used as a guide to ensure system tightness. Vacuum leaks can be detected by a change in operational pressures not supported by corresponding refrigerant temperature data or the frequency of purge unit operation. Pressure leaks are characterized by symptoms related to refrigerant charge loss such as low suction pressures and high suction superheat. Such leaks should be located and fixed to prevent component deterioration.
- Compliance with the manufacturer's recommended oil filter inspection and replacement schedule allows visual indication of the compressor lubrication system condition. Repetitive clogging of filters can mean system contamination. Periodic oil sample analysis can monitor acid, moisture, and particulate levels to assist in problem detection.

- Operating and safety controls should be checked periodically and calibrated to ensure reliability.
- Electrical resistance of hermetic motor windings between phases and to ground should be checked (megged) regularly, following the manufacturer's outlined procedure. This helps detect any internal electrical insulation deterioration or the formation of electrical leakage paths before a failure occurs.
- Water-cooled oil coolers should be systematically cleaned on the water side (depending on water conditions), and operation of any automatic water control valves should be checked.
- For some compressors, periodic maintenance (e.g., manual lubrication of couplings and other external components, shaft seal replacement) is required. Prime movers and their associated auxiliaries all require routine maintenance. Such items should be made part of the planned compressor maintenance schedule.
- Periodic vibration analysis can locate and identify trouble (e.g., unbalance, misalignment, bent shaft, worn or defective bearings, bad gears, mechanical looseness, electrical unbalance). Without disassembling the machine, such trouble can be found early, before machinery failure or damage can occur. Dynamic balancing can restore rotating equipment to its original efficient, quiet operating mode. Such testing can help avoid costly emergency repairs, pinpoint irregularities before major problems arise, and increase the useful life of components.
- The necessary steps for preparing the unit for prolonged shutdown (i.e., winter) and specified instruction for starting after this standby period, should both be part of the program. With compressors that have internal lubrication systems, provisions should be made to have their oil heaters energized continuously throughout this period or to have their oil charges replaced before putting them back into operation.

4.6 SYMBOLS

a = acoustic velocity at a particular point
A = area of cylinder (Equation [11]), m^2
a_i = acoustic velocity at impeller inlet
c = flow velocity
c_p = specific heat at constant pressure
CR = compression ratio
c_u = tangential component of refrigerant velocity leaving impeller blades, m/s
c_{ul} = RMS tangential component of refrigerant velocity entering impeller blades at R_{rms}, m/s
D = impeller diameter, or diameter of cylinder (Equation [12]), m
f = polytropic work factor
h_c = enthalpy at specific state point
H = cylinder block height
k = ratio of specific heats, Equation (46); isentropic coefficient for refrigerant used, from refrigerant tables (e.g., Lemmon et al. [2002])
m = exponent in Equation (33), defined in Equation (35)
$\dot{m}$ = ideal mass flow of compressed gas, kg/s
M = flow Mach number, Equation (22)
M_1 = first-stage impeller Mach number
M_i = flow Mach number impeller, Equation (24)
n = exponent, Equation (34)
N = rotational speed
N_1 = compressor speed, rpm
N_2 = motor speed, rpm
N_s = specific speed
p = pressure at a specific state point
P = gas compression power
p_1 = pressure on other side of piston, Pa
p_2 = discharge pressure, Pa
p_d = expected discharge pressure (absolute)
P_e = power input to motor
P_m = power input to shaft
p^m = pressure raised to power of m
P_o = ideal power input, W
P_{oi} = power required for isentropic compression
PR = pressure ratio = p_d/p_s
p_s = expected suction pressure (absolute)
Q = volumetric flow rate; actual capacity, W
Q/ND^3 = dimensionless flow coefficient
Q_i = volumetric flow rate in impeller
Q_o = ideal capacity, W
s = stroke of compressor, m
R = gas constant
R_{hub} = impeller inlet hub radius, cm
R_{shroud} = impeller inlet shroud radius, cm
R_{rms} = impeller inlet RMS radius, Equation (15); cm
T = absolute temperature at specific state point
T_s = starting torque, N·m
U_1 = impeller inlet RMS blade speed at R_{rms}, m/s
u_i = impeller tip speed
v = specific volume, m^3/kg
V_d = geometric displacement of compressor, m^3/s
V^n = volume raised to power of n
w = mass flow
W = total work input
w_a = work delivered to gas within the compression volume
w_e = work input to motor, J/kg
W_i = impeller work input per unit mass of refrigerant, J/kg
w_m = work input to compressor shaft, J/kg
w_{oi} = specific work of isentropic compression, J/kg
W_p = polytropic work input
W_{pi} = polytropic work by impeller
W_s = adiabatic work input
X = compressibility function, Equation (36)
Y = compressibility function, Equation (37)
Z = compressibility function, Equation (38)
η = polytropic efficiency
η_{com} = total compressor efficiency
η_e = motor efficiency
η_i = isentropic efficiency
η_m = mechanical efficiency
η_{oi} = compression isentropic efficiency
η_s = adiabatic efficiency
η_v = volumetric efficiency
μ = overall work coefficient
μ_i = stage work coefficient
ρ_s = density of gas entering compressor (at suction port), kg/m^3
Θ = flow parameter, Equation (26)
μ = overall work coefficient
Ω = head parameter, Equation (25)

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CHAPTER 39

CONDENSERS

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THE CONDENSER in a refrigeration system is a heat exchanger that rejects all the heat from the system. This heat consists of heat absorbed by the evaporator plus the heat from the energy input to the compressor. The compressor discharges hot, high-pressure refrigerant gas into the condenser, which rejects heat from the gas to some cooler medium. Thus, the cool refrigerant condenses back to the liquid state and drains from the condenser to continue in the refrigeration cycle.

Condensers may be classified by their cooling medium as (l) water-cooled, (2) air-cooled, (3) evaporative (air- and water-cooled), and (4) refrigerant-cooled (cascade systems). The first three types are discussed in this chapter; see Chapter 48 in the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* for a discussion of cascade-cooled condensers.

1. WATER-COOLED CONDENSERS

1.1 HEAT REMOVAL

The heat rejection rate in a condenser for each unit of heat removed by the evaporator may be estimated from the graph in Figure 1. The theoretical values shown are based on Refrigerant 22 with 5 K suction superheat, 5 K liquid subcooling, and 80% compressor efficiency. Depending on compressor efficiency, the heat removed could be higher or lower than these values. Usually, the heat rejection requirement can be accurately determined by adding the known evaporator load and the heat equivalent of the power required for compression (obtained from the compressor manufacturer's catalog). (Note that heat from the compressor is reduced by an independent heat rejection processes such as oil cooling, motor cooling, etc.)

The volumetric flow rate of condensing water required may be calculated as follows:

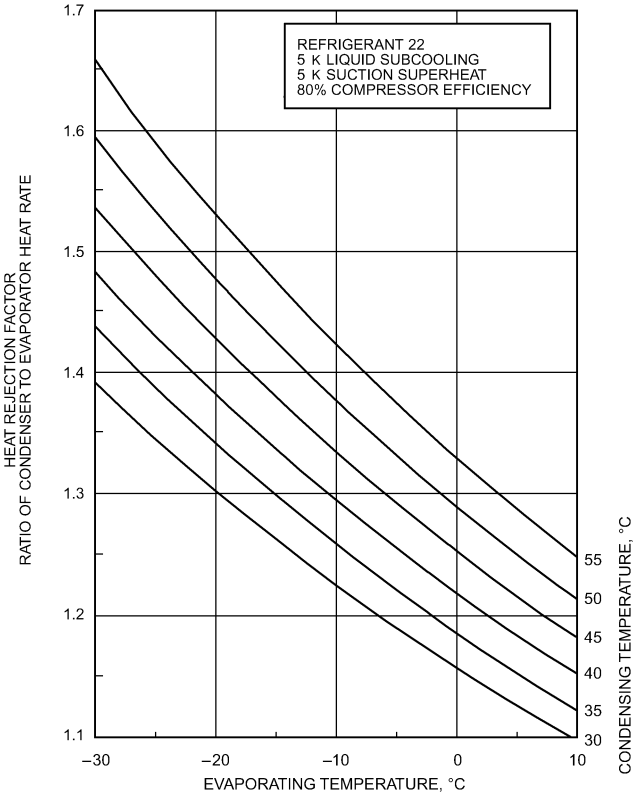


Fig. 1 Heat Removed in Condenser

$$Q = \frac{q_o}{\rho c_p (t_2 - t_1)} \quad (1)$$

where

Q = volumetric flow rate of water, m^3/s

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.4, Air-to-Refrigerant Heat Transfer Equipment; TC 8.5, Liquid-to-Refrigerant Heat Exchangers; and TC 8.6, Cooling Towers and Evaporative Condensers.

q_o = heat rejection rate, kW
ρ = density of water, kg/m^3
t_1 = temperature of water entering condenser, °C
t_2 = temperature of water leaving condenser, °C
c_p = specific heat of water at constant pressure, kJ/(kg·K)

Example 1. Estimate volumetric flow rate of condensing water required for the condenser of an R-22 water-cooled unit operating at a condensing temperature of 40°C, an evaporating temperature of 4°C, 5 K liquid subcooling, and 5 K suction superheat. Water enters the condenser at 30°C and leaves at 35°C. The refrigeration load is 300 kW.

Solution: From Figure 1, the heat rejection factor for these conditions is about 1.19.

$q_o = 1.19 \times 300 = 357$ kW
$\rho = 995$ kg/m^3 at 33°C
$c_p = 4.18$ kJ/(kg·K)

From Equation (1):

$$Q = \frac{357}{995 \times 4.18(35 - 30)} = 0.0172 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$$

1.2 HEAT TRANSFER

A water-cooled condenser transfers heat by sensible cooling in the gas desuperheating and condensate subcooling stages and by transfer of latent heat in the condensing stage. The condensing stage is by far the dominant process in normal refrigeration applications, accounting for approximately 83% of the heat rejection. Because the tube wall temperature is normally lower than the condensing temperature at all locations in the condenser, condensation takes place throughout the condenser.

The effect of changes in the entering gas superheat is typically insignificant because of an inverse proportional relationship between temperature difference and heat transfer coefficient. As a result, an average overall heat transfer coefficient and the mean temperature difference (calculated from the condensing temperature corresponding to the saturated condensing pressure and the entering and leaving water temperatures) give reasonably accurate predictions of performance.

Subcooling affects the average overall heat transfer coefficient when tubes are submerged in liquid. The heat rejection rate is then determined as

$$q = UA\Delta t_m \tag{2}$$

where

q = total heat transfer rate, W
U = overall heat transfer coefficient, W/(m^2·K)
A = heat transfer surface area associated with U, m^2
Δt_m = mean temperature difference, K

Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describes how to calculate Δt_m.

Overall Heat Transfer Coefficient

The overall heat transfer coefficient U_o in a **water-cooled condenser with water inside the tubes** may be computed from calculated or test-derived heat transfer coefficients of the water and refrigerant sides, from physical measurements of the condenser tubes, and from a fouling factor on the water side, using the following equation:

$$U_o = \frac{1}{\left(\frac{A_o}{A_i}\frac{1}{h_w}\right) + \left(\frac{A_o}{A_i}r_{fw}\right) + \left(\frac{A_o}{A_m}\frac{t}{k}\right) + \left(\frac{1}{h_r\phi_s}\right)} \tag{3}$$

where

U_o = overall heat transfer coefficient, based on external surface and mean temperature difference between external and internal fluids, W/(m^2·K)
A_o/A_i = ratio of external to internal surface area
h_w = internal or water-side film coefficient, W/(m^2·K)
r_{fw} = fouling resistance on water side, (m^2·K)/W
t = thickness of tube wall, m
k = thermal conductivity of tube material, W/(m·K)
A_o/A_m = ratio of external to mean heat transfer surface areas of metal wall
h_r = external or refrigerant-side coefficient, W/(m^2·K)
ϕ_s = surface fin efficiency (100% for bare tubes)

For **tube-in-tube condensers or other condensers where refrigerant flows inside the tubes**, the equation for U_o, in terms of water-side surface, becomes

$$U_o = \frac{1}{\left(\frac{A_o}{A_i}\frac{1}{h_r}\right) + r_{fw} + \left(\frac{t}{k}\right) + \left(\frac{1}{h_w}\right)} \tag{4}$$

where

h_r = internal or refrigerant-side coefficient, W/(m^2·K)
h_w = external or water-side coefficient, W/(m^2·K)

For **brazed or plate-and-frame condensers** $A_0 = A_i$; therefore the equation for U_o is

$$U_o = \frac{1}{(1/h_r) + r_{fw} + (t/k) + (1/h_w)} \tag{5}$$

where t is plate thickness.

Water-Side Film Coefficient

Values of the water-side film coefficient h_w may be calculated from equations in Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. For turbulent flow, at Reynolds numbers exceeding 10 000 in horizontal tubes and using average water temperatures, the general equation (McAdams 1954) is

$$\frac{h_w D}{k} = 0.023\left(\frac{DG}{\mu}\right)^{0.8}\left(\frac{c_p\mu}{k}\right)^{0.4} \tag{6}$$

where

D = inside tube diameter, m
k = thermal conductivity of water, W/(m·K)
G = mass velocity of water, kg/(s·m^2)
μ = viscosity of water, kg/(s·m)
c_p = specific heat of water at constant pressure, kJ/(kg·K)

The constant 0.023 in Equation (6) reflects plain inner diameter (ID) tubes. Bergles (1995) and Pate et al. (1991) discuss numerous water-side enhancement methods that increase the value of this constant.

Because of its strong influence on the value of h_w, keep water velocity high in general without initiating erosion or excessive pressure drop. Maximum velocities from 2 to 3 m/s are common with clean water. Experiments by Sturley (1975) at velocities up to approximately 8 m/s showed no damage to copper tubes after long operation. Water quality is the key factor affecting erosion potential (Ayub and Jones 1987). A minimum velocity of 1 m/s is good practice when water quality is such that noticeable fouling or corrosion could result. With clean water, the velocity may be lower if it must be conserved or has a low temperature. In some cases, the minimum flow may be determined by a lower Reynolds number limit.

For brazed or plate-and-frame condensers, the equation is similar to Equation (6). However, the diameter D is replaced by H, which is the characteristic spacing between plates.

Refrigerant-Side Film Coefficient

Factors influencing the value of the refrigerant-side film coefficient h_r are

- Type of refrigerant being condensed
- Geometry of condensing surface (plain tube outer diameter [OD]; finned-tube fin spacing, height, and cross-sectional profile; and plate geometry)
- Condensing temperature
- Condensing rate in terms of mass velocity or rate of heat transfer
- Arrangement of tubes in bundle and location of inlet and outlet connections
- Vapor distribution and rate of flow
- Condensate drainage
- Liquid subcooling

Values of refrigerant-side coefficients may be estimated from correlations in Chapter 5 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Information on the effects of refrigerant type, condensing temperature, and loading (temperature drop across the condensate film) on the condensing film coefficient is in the section on Condensing in the same chapter. Actual values of h_r for a given physical condenser design can be determined from test data using a Wilson plot (Briggs and Young 1969; McAdams 1954).

The type of condensing surface has a considerable effect on the condensing coefficient. Most halocarbon refrigerant condensers use finned tubes where the fins are integral with the tube. Water velocities normally used are large enough for the resulting high water-side film coefficient to justify using an extended external surface to balance the heat transfer resistances of the two surfaces. Pearson and Withers (1969) compared refrigerant condensing performance of integral finned tubes with different fin spacing. Some other refrigerant-side enhancements are described by Pate et al. (1991) and Webb (1984a). The effect of fin shape on the condensing coefficient is addressed by Kedzierski and Webb (1990). Ghaderi et al. (1995) reviewed in-tube condensation heat transfer correlations for smooth and augmented tubes.

In the case of brazed-plate or plate-and-frame condensers, inlet nozzle size, chevron angle, pitch, and depth of the nozzles are important design parameters. For trouble-free operation, refrigerant should flow counter to the water flow. Little specific design information is available; however, film thickness is certainly a factor in plate condenser design because of the falling-film nature along the vertical surface. Kedzierski (1997) showed that placing a brazed condenser in a horizontal position improved U_o by 17 to 30% because of the shorter film distance.

Huber et al. (1994a) determined condensing coefficients for R-134a, R-12, and R-11 condensing on conventional finned tubes with a fin spacing of 0.977 mm and a commercially available tube specifically developed for condensing halocarbon refrigerants (Huber et al. 1994b). This tube has a sawtooth-shaped outer enhancement. The data indicated that the condensing coefficients for the sawtoothed tube were approximately three times higher than for the conventional finned tube exchanger and two times higher for R-123.

Further, Huber et al. (1994c) found that, for tubes with 0.977 mm fin spacing, R-134a condensing coefficients were 20% larger than those for R-12 at a given heat flux. However, on the sawtoothed tube, R-134a condensing coefficients were nearly two times larger than those for R-12 at the same heat flux. The R-123 condensing coefficients were 10 to 30% larger than the R-11 coefficients at a given heat flux, with the largest differences occurring at the lowest heat fluxes tested. The differences in magnitude between the R-123 and R-11 condensing coefficients were the same for both the 0.977 mm fin spacing tube and the sawtoothed tube.

Physical aspects of a given condenser design (e.g., tube spacing and orientation, shell-side baffle arrangement, orientation of multiple water-pass arrangements, refrigerant connection locations, number of tubes high in the bundle) affect the refrigerant-side coefficient by influencing vapor distribution and flow through the tube bundle and condensate drainage from the bundle. Butterworth (1977) reviewed correlations accounting for these variables in predicting the heat transfer coefficient for shell-side condensation. These effects are also surveyed by Webb (1984b). Kistler et al. (1976) developed analytical procedures for design within these parameters.

As refrigerant condenses on the tubes, it falls on the tubes in lower rows. Because of the added resistance of this liquid film, the effective film coefficient for lower rows should be lower than that for upper rows. Therefore, the average overall refrigerant film coefficient should decrease as the number of tube rows increases. Webb and Murawski (1990) present row effect data for five tube geometries. However, the additional compensating effects of added film turbulence and direct contact condensation on the subcooled liquid film make actual row effect uncertain.

Huber et al. (1994c, 1994d) determined that the row effect on finned tubes is nearly negligible when condensing low-surface-tension refrigerants such as R-134a. However, the finned-tube film coefficient for higher-surface-tension refrigerants such as R-123 can drop by as much as 20% in lower bundle rows. The row effect for the sawtoothed condensing tube is quite large for both R-134a and R-123, because the film coefficient drops by nearly 80% from top to bottom in a 30-row bundle.

Randall and Eckels (2005a, 2005b) measured refrigerant-side coefficients for smooth, finned, and three-dimensionally enhanced tube surfaces with and without liquid inundation for R-134a. The results show that the three-dimensionally enhanced tube surfaces had the highest refrigerant-side coefficients at low inundation conditions, but their performance was most sensitive to inundation rates. The refrigerant-side coefficient of the finned tube was found to be less sensitive to inundation rates that those of the three-dimensionally enhanced tubes.

Eckels (2007) studied the effect of two lubricating oils on the refrigerant-side coefficient during condensation of R-134a for smooth, finned, and three-dimensionally enhanced tube surfaces at varying oil concentrations. The reduction in refrigerant-side coefficient caused by oil for all three tube types was found to be less than 15% for all three tube types, and independent of oil concentration.

Honda et al. (1994, 1995) demonstrated that row effects caused by condensate drainage and inundation are less for staggered tube bundles than for in-line tubes. In addition, performance improvements as high as 85% were reported for optimized two-dimensional fin profiles compared to conventional fin profiles. The optimized fin profiles differed from the sawtoothed profile tested by Huber et al. (1994b) primarily in that external fins were not notched. This observation, coupled with the differences in row effects between sawtoothed and conventional fin profiles reported by Huber et al. (1994c, 1994d), suggested that there is opportunity for further development and commercialization of two-dimensional fin profiles for large shell-and-tube heat exchanger applications.

Liquid refrigerant may be subcooled by raising the condensate level to submerge a desired number of tubes. The refrigerant film coefficient associated with the submerged tubes is less than the condensing coefficient. If the refrigerant film coefficient in Equation (3) is an average based on all tubes in the condenser, its value decreases as a greater portion of the tubes is submerged.

Tube-Wall Resistance

Most refrigeration condensers, except those using ammonia, have relatively thin-walled copper tubes. Where these are used, the temperature drop or gradient across the tube wall is not significant. If the tube metal has a high thermal resistance, as does 70/30 cupronickel, a considerable temperature drop occurs or, conversely, an increase in the mean temperature difference Δt_m or the surface area is required to transfer the same amount of heat as copper. Although the tube-wall resistance t/k in Equations (3) and (4) is an approximation, as long as the wall thickness is not more than 14% of the tube diameter, the error will be less than 1%. To improve the accuracy of the wall resistance calculation for heavy tube walls or low-conductivity material, see Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Surface Efficiency

For a finned tube, a temperature gradient exists from the root of a fin to its tip because of the fin material's thermal resistance. The surface efficiency ϕ_s can be calculated from the fin efficiency, which accounts for this effect. For tubes with low-conductivity material, high fins, or high values of fin pitch, the fin efficiency becomes increasingly significant. Wolverine Tube (1984, 2004-2010) and Young and Ward (1957) describe methods to evaluate these effects.

Fouling Factor

Manufacturers' ratings are based on clean equipment with an allowance for possible water-side fouling. The fouling factor r_{fw} is a thermal resistance referenced to the water-side area of the heat transfer surface. Thus, the temperature penalty imposed on the condenser equals the water-side heat flux multiplied by the fouling factor. Increased fouling increases overall heat transfer resistance because of the parameter $(A_o/A_i)r_{fw}$ in Equation (3). Fouling increases the Δt_m required to obtain the same capacity (with a corresponding increase in condenser pressure and system power) or lowers capacity.

Allowance for a given fouling factor has a greater influence on equipment selection than simply increasing the overall resistance (Starner 1976). Increasing the surface area lowers the water velocity. Consequently, the increase in heat transfer surface required for the same performance derives from both fouling resistance and the additional resistance that results from lower water velocity.

For a given tube surface, load, and water temperature range, the tube length can be optimized to give a desired condensing temperature and water-side pressure drop. The solid curves in Figure 2 show the effect on water velocity, tube length, and overall surface required due to increased fouling. A fouling factor of 130 $(mm^2 \cdot K)/W$ doubles the required surface area compared to that with no fouling allowance.

A worse case occurs when an oversized condenser must be selected to meet increased fouling requirements but without the flexibility of increasing tube length. As shown by the dashed lines in Figure 2, water velocity decreases more rapidly as the total surface increases to meet the required performance. Here, the required surface area doubles with a fouling factor of only 86 $(mm^2 \cdot K)/W$. If the application can afford more pumping power, water flow may be increased to obtain a higher velocity, which increases the water film heat transfer coefficient. This factor, plus the lower leaving water temperature, reduces the condensing temperature.

Fouling is a major unresolved problem in heat exchanger design (Taborek et al. 1972). The major uncertainty is which fouling factor to choose for a given application or water condition to obtain expected performance from the condenser: too low a fouling factor wastes compressor power, whereas too high a factor wastes heat exchanger material.

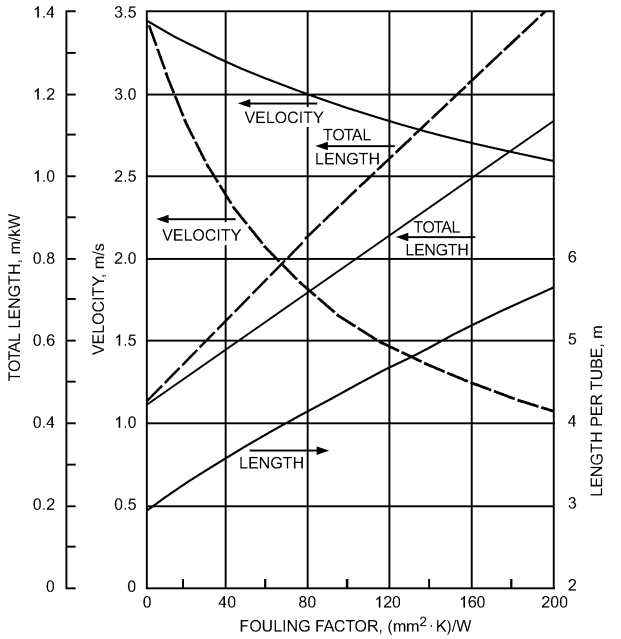


Fig. 2 Effect of Fouling on Condenser

Fouling may result from sediment, biological growth, or corrosive products. Scale results from deposition of chemicals from the cooling water on the warmer surface of the condenser tube. Chapter 50 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* discusses water chemistry and water treatment factors that are important in controlling corrosion and scale in condenser cooling water.

Tables of fouling factors are available; however, in many cases, the values are greater than necessary (TEMA 1999). Extensive research generally found that fouling resistance reaches an asymptotic value with time (Suitor et al. 1976). Much fouling research is based on surface temperatures that are considerably higher than those found in air-conditioning and refrigeration condensers. Coates and Knudsen (1980) and Lee and Knudsen (1979) found that, in the absence of suspended solids or biological fouling, long-term fouling of condenser tubes does not exceed 35 $(mm^2 \cdot K)/W$, and short-term fouling does not exceed 18 $(mm^2 \cdot K)/W$ (ASHRAE 1982). These studies resulted in a standard industry fouling value of 44 $(mm^2 \cdot K)/W$ for condenser ratings (AHRI *Guideline* E-1997). Periodic cleaning of condenser tubes (mechanically or chemically) usually maintains satisfactory performance, except in severe environments. Consult AHRI *Standard* 450 for water-cooled condensers when reviewing manufacturers' ratings. This standard describes methods to correct ratings for different values of fouling.

Recent ASHRAE research (Cremaschi et al. 2011) studied precipitation-based fouling characteristics (corrosion and biological fouling were absent) on brazed-plate heat exchangers in condenser applications with cooling towers. They found that the internal geometry of the plates significantly influenced the asymptotic fouling factor value under severe fouling conditions. Under moderate fouling conditions, the asymptotic fouling value was 0.000044 $(m^2 \cdot K)/W$ for all chevron angles (as defined in Chapter 4 of 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). Under severe fouling conditions, a hard corrugation (chevron angle 30°) resulted in an asymptotic fouling

value of 0.00044 ($m^2 \cdot K$)/W, whereas for soft corrugations (chevron angle 60°) it was estimated as 0.000065 ($m^2 \cdot K$)/W. Although the aspect ratio had minimal impact on asymptotic fouling value, heat exchangers with longer plates in the direction of flow exhibited an oscillatory fouling behavior.

1.3 WATER PRESSURE DROP

Water (or other fluid) pressure drop is important for designing or selecting condensers. Where a cooling tower cools condensing water, water pressure drop through the condenser is generally limited to about 70 kPa. If condenser water comes from another source, pressure drop through the condenser should be lower than the available pressure to allow for pressure fluctuations and additional flow resistance caused by fouling.

Pressure drop through horizontal condensers includes loss through the tubes, tube entrance and exit losses, and losses through the heads or return bends (or both). The effect of tube coiling must be considered in shell-and-coil condensers. Expected pressure drop through tubes can be calculated from a modified Darcy-Weisbach equation:

$$\Delta p = N_p \left(K_H + f\frac{L}{D}\right)\frac{\rho V^2}{2} \quad (7)$$

where

Δp = pressure drop, Pa
N_p = number of tube passes
K_H = entrance and exit flow resistance and flow reversal coefficient
f = friction factor
L = length of tube, m
D = inside tube diameter, m
ρ = fluid density, kg/m^3
V = fluid velocity, m/s

For tubes with smooth inside diameters, the friction factor may be determined from a Moody chart or various relations, depending on the flow regime and wall roughness (see Chapter 3 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*). For tubes with internal enhancement, the friction factor should be obtained from the tube manufacturer.

The value of K_H depends on tube entry and exit conditions and the flow path between passes. A minimum recommended value is 1.5. This factor is more critical with short tubes.

Predicting pressure drop for shell-and-coil condensers is more difficult than for shell-and-tube condensers because of the curvature of the coil and flattening or kinking of the tubes as they are bent. Seban and McLaughlin (1963) discuss the effect of curvature or bending of pipe and tubes on the pressure drop.

For brazed and plate-and-frame condensers, the total pressure drop is the sum of the pressure drop in the plate region and the pressure drops associated with the entry/exit ports. The general form of equation is similar to Equation (7) except $N_p = 1$.

1.4 LIQUID SUBCOOLING

The amount of condensate subcooling provided by the condensing surface in a shell-and-tube condenser is small, generally less than 1 K. When more subcooling is required, it may be obtained by submerging tubes in the condensate. Tubes in the lower portion of the bundle are used for this purpose. If the condenser is multipass, then the subcooling tubes should be included in the first pass to gain exposure to the coolest water.

When means are provided to submerge the subcooler tubes to a desired level in the condensate, heat is transferred principally by natural convection. Subcooling performance can be improved by enclosing tubes in a separate compartment in the condenser to obtain the benefits of forced convection over the enclosed tubes.

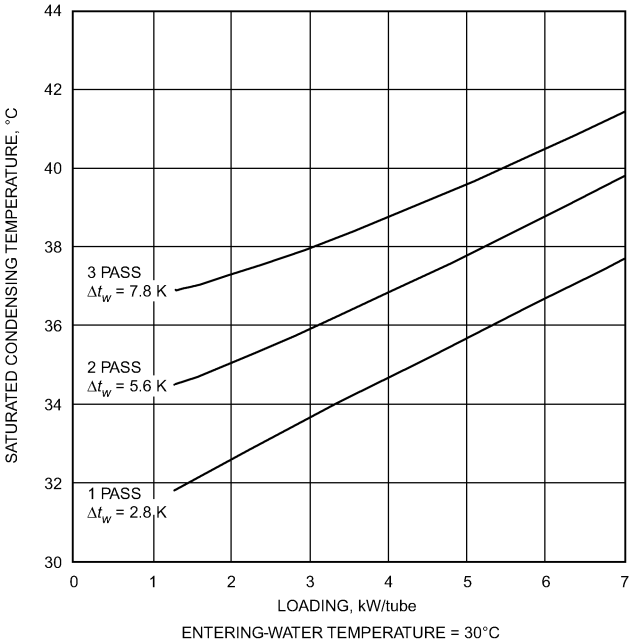


Fig. 3 Effect of Condenser Water Circuiting

Segmental baffles may be provided to produce flow across the tube bundle. Kern and Kraus (1972) describe how heat transfer performance can be estimated analytically by use of longitudinal or cross-flow correlations, but it is more easily determined by test because of the large number of variables. Refrigerant pressure drop along the flow path should not exceed the pressure difference allowed by the saturation pressure of the subcooled liquid.

1.5 WATER CIRCUITING

Varying water flow rate in a condenser can significantly affect the saturated condensing temperature, which affects performance of the refrigeration system. Figure 3 shows the change in condensing temperature for one, two, or three passes in a particular condenser. For example, at a loading of 6000 W per tube, a two-pass condenser with a 5.6 K range would have a condensing temperature of 39.3°C. At the same load with a one-pass, 2.8 K range, this unit would have a condensing temperature of 37.6°C. The one-pass option does, however, require twice the water flow rate with an associated increase in pumping power. Three-pass design may be favorable when costs associated with water flow outweigh gains from a lower condensing temperature. Hence, different numbers of passes (if an option) and ranges should be considered against other parameters (water source, pumping power, cooling tower design, etc.) to optimize overall performance and cost.

1.6 TYPES

The most common types of water-cooled refrigerant condensers are (1) shell-and-tube, (2) shell-and-coil, (3) tube-in-tube, and (4) brazed-plate. The type selected depends on the cooling load, refrigerant used, quality and temperature of the available cooling water, amount of water that can be circulated, location and space allotment, required operating pressures (water and refrigerant sides), and cost and maintenance concerns.

Shell-and-Tube Condensers

Built in sizes from 3 to 35 000 kW, these condensers condense refrigerant outside the tubes and circulate cooling water through the

tubes in a single or multipass circuit. Fixed-tube-sheet, straight-tube construction is usually used, although U-tubes that terminate in a single tube sheet are sometimes used. Typically, shell-and-tube condenser tubes run horizontally. Where floor installation area is limited, the tubes may be vertical, but this orientation has poor condensate draining, which reduces the refrigerant film coefficient. Vertical condensers with open water systems have been used with ammonia.

Use care when locating gas inlet and liquid outlet nozzles. The proximity of these nozzles may adversely affect condenser performance by requiring excessive amounts of liquid refrigerant to seal the outlet nozzle from inlet gas flow. This effect can be diminished by adding baffles at the inlet and/or outlet connection.

Halocarbon refrigerant condensers have been made with many materials, including all prime surface or finned, ferrous, or nonferrous tubes. Common tubes are nominal 19 to 25 mm OD copper tubes with integral fins on the outside. These tubes are often available with fin heights from 0.9 to 1.5 mm and fin spacings of 1.33, 0.98, and 0.64 mm. For ammonia condensers, prime surface steel tubes, 32 mm OD and 2.4 mm average wall thickness, are common.

Many tubes designed for enhanced heat transfer are available (Bergles 1995). Common enhancements on the inside surfaces include longitudinal or spiral grooves and ridges, internal fins, and other devices to promote turbulence and augment heat transfer. On the refrigerant side, condensate surface tension and drainage are important in the surface design. Tubes are available with the outer surfaces machined or formed specifically to enhance condensation and promote drainage. Heat transfer design equations for these enhanced tubes should be obtained from the manufacturer.

The electrohydrodynamics (EHD) technique couples a high-voltage, low-current electric field with the flow field in a fluid with low electrical conductivity to achieve higher heat transfer coefficients. Ohadi et al. (1995) experimentally demonstrated enhancement factors in excess of tenfold for both boiling and condensation of refrigerants such as R-134a. For condensation, the technique responds equally well to augmentation of condensation over (or inside) both vertical and horizontal tubes. Most passive augmentation techniques perform poorly for condensation enhancement in vertical orientation. Additional details of the EHD technique are in Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Because water and refrigerant film resistances with enhanced tubes are reduced, the effect of fouling becomes more significant. Where high levels of fouling occur, fouling may easily account for over 50% of the total resistance. In such cases, the advantages of enhancement may diminish. On the other hand, water-side augmentation, which creates turbulence, may reduce fouling. The actual value of fouling resistances depends on the particular type of enhancement and service conditions (Starner 1976; Watkinson et al. 1974).

Similarly, refrigerant-side enhancements may not show as much benefit in very large tube bundles as in smaller bundles. This is because of the row effect addressed in the section on Refrigerant-Side Film Coefficient.

The tubes are either brazed into thin copper, copper alloy, or steel tube sheets, or rolled into heavier nonferrous or steel tube sheets. Straight tubes with a maximum OD less than the tube hole diameter and rolled into tube sheets are removable. This construction facilitates field repair in the event of tube failure.

The required heat transfer area for a shell-and-tube condenser can be found by solving Equations (1), (2), and (3). The mean temperature difference is the logarithmic mean temperature difference, with entering and leaving refrigerant temperatures taken as the saturated condensing temperature. Depending on the parameters fixed, an iterative solution may be required.

Shell-and-U-tube condenser design principles are the same as those outlined for horizontal shell-and-tube units, with one exception: water pressure drop through the U-bend of the U-tube is generally less than that through the compartments in the water header where the direction of water flow is reversed. The pressure loss is a function of the inside tube diameter and the ratio of the inside tube diameter to bending centers. Pressure loss should be determined by test.

Shell-and-Coil Condensers

Shell-and-coil condensers circulate cooling water through one or more continuous or assembled coils contained within the shell. The refrigerant condenses outside the tubes. Capacities range from 1.75 to 50 kW. Because of the type of construction, the tubes are neither replaceable nor mechanically cleanable.

Equations (1), (2), and (3) may be used for performance calculations of shell-and-coil condensers, with the saturated condensing temperature used for the entering and leaving refrigerant temperatures in the logarithmic mean temperature difference. The values of h_w (the water-side film coefficient) and, especially, the pressure loss on the water side require close attention; laminar flow can exist at considerably higher Reynolds numbers in coils than in straight tubes. Because the film coefficient for turbulent flow is greater than that for laminar flow, h_w as calculated from Equation (6) will be too high if the flow is not turbulent. Once flow has become turbulent, the film coefficient will be greater than that for a straight tube (Eckert 1963). Pressure drop through helical coils can be much greater than through smooth, straight tubes for the same length of travel. The section on Water Pressure Drop outlines the variables that make accurate determination of the pressure loss difficult. Pressure loss and heat transfer rate should be determined by test because of the many variables inherent in this condenser.

Tube-in-Tube Condensers

These condensers consist of one or more assemblies of two tubes, one within the other, in which the refrigerant vapor is condensed in either the annular space or the inner tube. These units are built in sizes ranging from 1 to 180 kW. Both straight-tube and axial-tube (coaxial) condensers are available.

Equations (1) and (2) can be used to size a tube-in-tube condenser. Because the refrigerant may undergo a significant pressure loss through its flow path, the refrigerant temperatures used to calculate the mean temperature difference should be selected carefully. Refrigerant temperatures should be consistent with the model used for the refrigerant film coefficient. The logarithmic mean temperature difference for either counterflow or parallel flow should be used, depending on the piping connections. Equation (3) can be used to find the overall heat transfer coefficient when water flows in the tubes, and Equation (4) may be used when water flows in the annulus.

Tube-in-tube condenser design differs from those outlined previously, depending on whether the water flows through the inner tube or through the annulus. Condensing coefficients are more difficult to predict when condensation occurs within a tube or annulus, because the process differs considerably from condensation on the outside of a horizontal tube. Where water flows through the annulus, disagreement exists regarding the appropriate method that should be used to calculate the water-side film coefficient and the water pressure drop. The problem is further complicated if the tubes are spiraled.

The water side is mechanically cleanable only when the water flows in straight tubes and cleanout access is provided. Tubes are not replaceable.

Brazed-Plate and Plate-and-Frame Condensers

Brazed-plate condensers are constructed of plates brazed together to form an assembly of separate channels. Capacities range

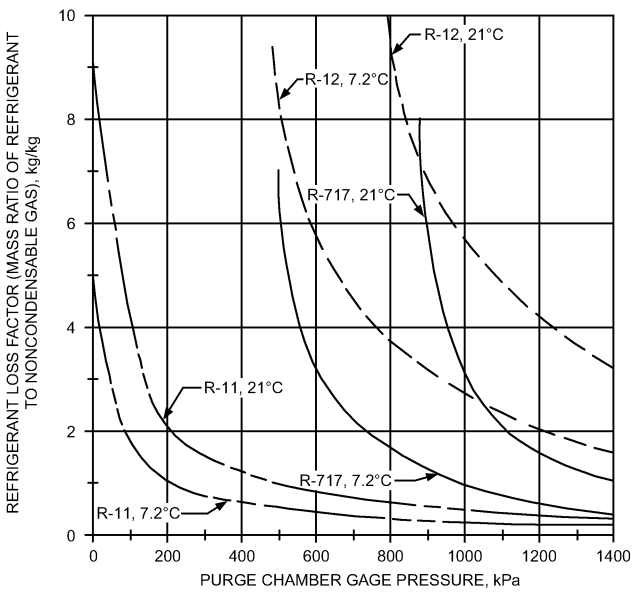


Fig. 4 Loss of Refrigerant During Purging at Various Gas Temperatures and Pressures

from 1.75 to 350 kW. The plate-and-frame condenser is a standard design in which plate pairs are laser-welded to form a single cassette. Refrigerant is confined to the space between the welded plates and is exposed to gaskets only at the ports. Such condensers have a higher range of capacity.

The plates, typically stainless steel, are usually configured with a wave pattern, which results in high turbulence and low susceptibility to fouling. The design has some ability to withstand freezing and, because of the compact design, requires a low refrigerant charge. The construction of brazed units does not allow mechanical cleaning, and internal leaks usually cannot be repaired. Thus, it can be beneficial to use filtration or separators on open cooling towers to keep the water clean, or to use closed-circuit cooling towers. Plate-and-frame units can be cleaned on the water side.

Performance calculations are similar to those for other condensers; however, very few correlations are available for the heat transfer coefficients.

1.7 NONCONDENSABLE GASES

When first assembled, most refrigeration systems contain gases, usually air and water vapor. These gases are detrimental to condenser performance, so it is important to evacuate the entire refrigeration system before operation.

For low-pressure refrigerants, where the operating pressure of the evaporator is less than ambient pressure, even slight leaks can be a continuing source of noncondensables. In such cases, a purge system, which automatically expels noncondensable gases, is recommended. Figure 4 shows some examples of refrigerant loss associated with using purging devices at various operating conditions. As a general rule, purging devices should emit less than one part refrigerant per part of air as rated in accordance with AHRI *Standard* 580 (see ASHRAE *Standard* 147).

When present, noncondensable gases collect on the high-pressure side of the system and raise the condensing pressure above that corresponding to the temperature at which the refrigerant is actually condensing. This increases power consumption and reduces capacity. Also, if oxygen is present at a point of high discharge temperature, the oil may oxidize.

The excess pressure is caused by the partial pressure of the noncondensable gas. These gases form a resistance film over some of the condensing surface, thus lowering the heat transfer coefficient. Webb et al. (1980) showed how a small percentage of noncondensables can cause major decreases in the refrigerant film coefficient in shell-and-tube condensers. (See Chapter 5 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.) The impact of noncondensable gases is difficult to characterize because such gases tend to accumulate in the coldest and least agitated part of the condenser or in the receiver. Thus, a fairly high percentage of noncondensables can be tolerated if the gases are confined to areas far from the heat transfer surface. One way to account for noncondensables is to treat them as a refrigerant or gas-side fouling resistance in Equation (3). Some predictions are presented by Wanniarachchi and Webb (1982).

As an example of the effect on system performance, experiments performed on a 880 kW R-11 chiller condenser revealed that 2% noncondensables by volume caused a 15% reduction in the condensing coefficient. Also, 3% and 8% noncondensables by volume caused power increases of 2.6% and 5%, respectively (Wanniarachchi and Webb 1982).

Huber et al. (1994b) determined that noncondensable gases have a more severe effect on the condensing coefficient of tubes with sawtoothed enhancements than on conventional finned tubes. For a noncondensable gas concentration of 0.5%, the coefficient for the tube with a fin spacing of 0.977 mm dropped by 15%, whereas the coefficient for the sawtoothed tube dropped by nearly 40%. At a noncondensable concentration of 5%, degradation was similar for both tubes.

The presence of noncondensable gases can be tested by shutting down the refrigeration system while allowing the condenser water to flow long enough for the refrigerant to reach the same temperature as the water. If the condenser pressure is higher than the pressure corresponding to the refrigerant temperature, noncondensable gases are present. This test may not be sensitive enough to detect the presence of small amounts of noncondensables, which can, nevertheless, decrease shell-side condensing coefficients.

1.8 TESTING AND RATING

Pressure vessels must be constructed and tested under the rules of appropriate codes and standards. The introduction of the current ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*, Section VIII, gives guidance on rules and exemptions.

The more common applicable codes and standards include the following:

- AHRI *Standard* 450 covers industry criteria for standard equipment, standard safety provisions, marking, fouling factors, and recommended rating points for water-cooled condensers.
- ASHRAE *Standard* 22 covers recommended testing methods.
- AHRI *Standard* 580 covers methods of testing, evaluating, and rating the efficiency of noncondensate gas purge equipment.
- ASHRAE *Standard* 15 specifies design criteria, use of materials, and testing. It refers to the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*, Section VIII, for refrigerant-containing sides of pressure vessels, where applicable. Factory test pressures are specified, and minimum design working pressures are given by this code. This code requires pressure-limiting and pressure-relief devices on refrigerant-containing systems, as applicable, and defines the setting and capacity requirements for these devices.
- ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code,* Section VIII covers the safety aspects of design and construction. Most states require condensers to meet these requirements if they fall within the scope of the ASME code. Some of the exceptions from meeting the requirements listed in the ASME code are as follows:
  - Condenser shell ID is 150 mm or less.

- Working pressure is 103 kPa (gage) or less.
- The fluid (water) portion of the condenser need not be built to the requirements of the ASME code if the fluid is water or an aqueous glycol solution, the design pressure does not exceed 2.07 MPa (gage), and the design temperature does not exceed 99°C.

  Condensers meeting the requirements of the ASME code will have an ASME stamp. The ASME stamp is a U or UM inside a four-leaf clover. The U can be used for all condensers; the UM can be used (considering local codes) for those with net refrigerant-side volume less than 42 L if less than 4.14 MPa (gage), or less than 141 L if less than 1.72 MPa (gage).
- UL *Standard* 207 covers specific design criteria, use of materials, testing, and initial approval by Underwriters Laboratories. A condenser with the ASME U stamp does not require UL approval.

Design Pressure

Refrigerant-side pressure should be chosen per ASHRAE *Standard* 15. Standby temperature and temperatures encountered during shipping of units with a refrigerant charge should also be considered.

Required fluid- (water-) side pressure varies, depending largely on the following conditions: static pressure, pump pressure, transients due to pump start-up, and valve closing. A common water-side design pressure is 1.0 MPa (gage), although with taller building construction, requirements for 2.0 MPa (gage) are not uncommon.

1.9 OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE

When a water-cooled condenser is selected, anticipated operating conditions, including water and refrigerant temperatures, have usually been determined. Standard practice allows for a fouling factor in the selection procedure. A new condenser, therefore, operates at a condensing temperature lower than the design point because it has not yet fouled. Once a condenser starts to foul or scale, economic considerations determine how frequently it should be cleaned. As scale builds up, the condensing temperature and subsequent power increase while the unit capacity decreases. Figure 5 shows this effect for a condenser with a design fouling factor of 44 $(mm^2 \cdot K)/W$. At some point, the increased cost of power can be offset by the labor cost of cleaning.

Local water conditions, as well as the effectiveness of chemical water treatment, if used, make the use of any specific maintenance schedule difficult. Cleaning can be done either mechanically with a brush or chemically with an acid solution. In applications where water-side fouling may be severe, online cleaning can be accomplished by brushes installed in cages in the water heads. By using valves, flow is reversed at set intervals, propelling the brushes through the tubes (Kragh 1975). The most effective method depends on the type of scale formed. Expert advice in selecting the particular method of tube cleaning is advisable.

Occasionally, one or more tubes may develop leaks because of corrosive impurities in the water or through improper cleaning. These leaks must be found and repaired as soon as possible; this is normally done by replacing the leaky tubes, a procedure best done through the original condenser manufacturer. In large condensers, where the contribution of a single tube is relatively insignificant, a simpler approach may be to seal the ends of the leaking tube.

If the condenser is located where water can freeze during the winter, special precautions should be taken when it is idle. Opening all vents and drains may be sufficient, but water heads should be removed and tubes blown free of water.

If refrigerant vapor is to be released from the condenser and there is water in the tubes, the pumps should be on and the water flowing. Otherwise, freezing can occur.

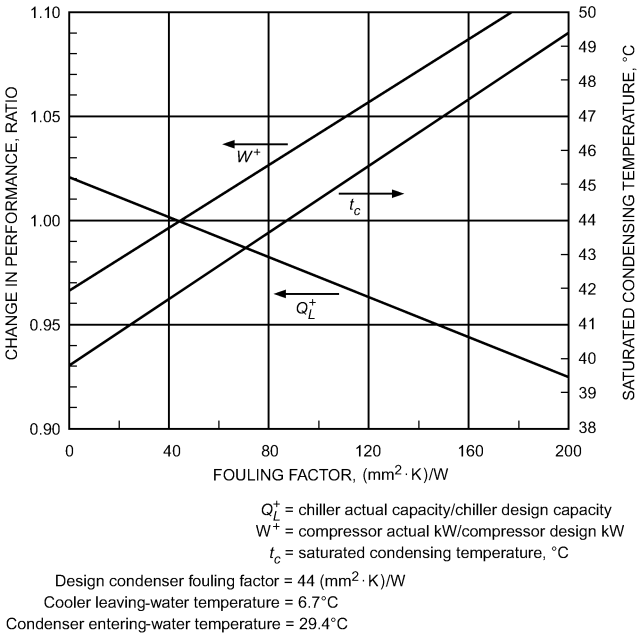


Fig. 5 Effect of Fouling on Chiller Performance

The condenser manufacturer's installation recommendations on orientation, piping connections, space requirements for tube cleaning or removal, and other important factors should be followed.

2. AIR-COOLED CONDENSERS

An air-cooled condenser uses ambient air to remove the heat of condensation from the refrigerant in a compression-type refrigeration system. Individual air-cooled condensers range in size from a few hundred watts to about 350 kW, though individual units may be coupled together for larger systems. The smallest air-cooled condensers are used in residential refrigerators and may have no fans, relying only on gravity circulation of the ambient air. Larger condensers almost always use one or more motor-driven fans for air circulation. Midsized condensers are frequently provided as part of an integral package (called a condensing unit) with the compressor. All but the smallest condensers use finned coils, which may be formed or otherwise bent around a compressor/fan combination to form outdoor residential condensing units up to about 17.5 kW. Larger air-cooled condensers almost always use coils with a rectangular profile, either flat or with a single corner bent shape, and a minimum number of rows of finned tubing. Fans may be positioned to either draw or blow the air though the condenser coil. Fan motors are generally connected to operate when the compressor operates.

Air-cooled condensers may be located either adjacent to or remote from the compressor and may be designed for indoor or outdoor operation. For indoor use, larger condensers use centrifugal fans for ducted discharge to the outdoors. Outdoor coil orientation is generally horizontal, with propeller fans above the coil providing draw-through air circulation. For nonstandard applications, air discharge may be either vertical (top) or horizontal (side). Interconnecting piping connects the condenser coil to the compressor and to the expansion device or a liquid receiver.

2.1 TYPES

Air-cooled condensers vary in air- and refrigerant-side design, but there are three main coil construction types: plate-and-fin, integral-fin, and microchannel.

Plate-and-Fin

Coils are commonly constructed of copper, aluminum, or steel tubes, ranging from 6 to 20 mm in diameter. For fluorocarbon and hydrocarbon refrigerants, copper is most common. Aluminum or steel tube condensers are generally used for ammonia. Fins attached to the tubes can be aluminum or copper.

Copper tubes generally have a round profile, with fins perpendicularly bound to their exterior. This arrangement normally requires no further air-side protection but may be prone to corrode when subject to some industrial or furnace flue gases, or salt-atmosphere-induced oxidation. Some inherent corrosion protection is provided by the slight galvanic effect of aluminum fins. Aluminum round-tube coil manufacturing is similar to that of round copper tube coils, except gas shield arc welding or special brazing alloys are used for joints. Corrosion protection is necessary for aluminum-to-copper joints. Steel tube condensers with steel fins are painted for indoor use or hot-dip galvanized for outdoor applications. Brazed-steel condensers are very common on small refrigeration units.

Tube diameter selection compromises between factors such as compactness, manufacturing tooling cost, header arrangement, air resistance, and refrigerant flow resistance. A smaller diameter gives more flexibility in coil circuit design and a lower refrigerant charge, but at increased cost.

Other core tubing choices include copper tube that is internally enhanced by fins or grooves known as microfin tubing. The helical microfinning is very small, on the order of 0.2 mm height in a tiny spiral with an optimum helical angle of 15 to 20° throughout the internal surface of the tube. Over 60 such grooved fins could fit in a 9.5 mm tube's cross section. This pattern is common on seamless (drawn) tubes; on welded (strip) tubes, internal grooving can be augmented with a double cross-hatch fin pattern. Although a microfin tube has a significant refrigerant-side heat transfer advantage, tube-side effect does not have dominant heat transfer conductance in the coil's overall heat transfer function. The majority of heat transfer resistance is on the air side, primarily because of an extended fin surface. Usually, an air-cooled condenser's fin-to-tube β ratio is around 25 to 1. Therefore, a 50% increase in tube-side heat transfer by microfinning may result in only a 5 to 15% overall heat transfer coefficient gain in the coil design, depending on refrigerant type, its transport velocities, and the fin surface enhancement used. Occasionally, a bare-tube condenser (i.e., without a secondary surface) is used where airborne dirt loading is expected to be excessive. For these applications, enhanced bare-tube coils could be half the size of regular bare-tube coils.

When conditions are normal, and even in a saline atmosphere, a copper tube aluminum-finned coil is generally used. The most common is the aluminum plate fin, from 0.3 to 0.15 mm thick. Most plate fins have extruded tube collars. Straight tubes are passed through these nested fin collars and expanded to fit the collars by either mechanical or, less frequently, hydraulic expansion. This results in a rigid coil assembly that has maximum tube-to-fin thermal conductance. Spiral- and spline-fin coils, tightly wound onto the individual tubes that make up the coil core, are also used. Common fin spacing for each type ranges from 1.3 to 3.2 mm.

Stock fin coatings, as well as entire (completed) coil dip-process coatings, are readily available from specialty chemical processors. These coatings are for use in specific corrosive atmospheres, especially in a dry-surface coil application, such as aluminum-finned air-cooled condenser coils in seacoast environments

Integral-Fin

Integral-fin condensers can be made of either copper of aluminum. These condensers are made by extruding or forming fins directly from the tube material. Copper tubing can be formed using cold compression to form large fins on the outside of the tubing. Where the internal heat transfer coefficient is important, these formed tubes can be stacked to form condensers. Using aluminum, the common method of forming condensers is to rake the surface of the tubing to form protrusions. Because aluminum is a very soft material, these tubes with the "spiny" fins can be coiled to form complete condensers.

Microchannel

Small all-aluminum condensers, used in automotive and aviation applications where lightness and compactness are paramount, are made with flattened tubes having hydraulic radii from 0.25 to 3 mm. These oval tubes are formed into serpentines with zigzag aluminum fins nested horizontally between tubing runs. New, improved versions of these heat exchangers feature individual oval tubes connected to manifold header assemblies. The entire assembly is furnace-brazed and a diffusion layer of zinc applied for corrosion protection. This type of flat tube and horizontal fin arrangement has evolved into **microchannel coils**, which are used in residential condensing units and commercial air-conditioning systems. Although an advancement, they have some limitations that are uncommon in conventional coils.

Functioning solely as a condenser, microchannel coils have a higher heat transfer efficiency than a conventional plate or spine-fin coil, both per unit volume and per unit surface area. Manufacturers' laboratory tests have shown microchannel coils, compared to a conventional 2 mm fin spacing, flat-fin, 9.5 mm copper tube core, to be 90% higher in heat transfer coefficient for similar face areas. Compared to an 18-spine fin spiral design, 9.5 mm aluminum tube, this brazed aluminum design appears to be 44% higher in heat transfer coefficient. In addition to lower air-side pressure drop, microchannel refrigerant-side pressure drop tends to be lower, depending on circuitry. However, equal refrigerant distribution in the inlet header is less favorable than with conventional coils. Another use restriction is in the heat pump reverse cycle: horizontal-tube and horizontal-fin construction gives microchannel coils a less than desirable high defrost (condensate) water retention ability. Versatility is thus restricted to a specific unit's size and design, and not one-fits-many as for conventional coil designs. The equipment designer should consider how to avoid such deficits, including field repair not being an option, when applying microchannel coils at the system level.

2.2 FANS AND AIR REQUIREMENTS

Condenser coils can be cooled by natural convection or wind or by propeller, centrifugal, and vaneaxial fans. Because efficiency increases sharply by increasing air speed across the coil, forced convection with fans predominates.

Unless unusual operating or application conditions exist, fan/motor selections are made by balancing operating and first costs with size and sound requirements. Common air quantities are 80 to 160 L/s (4.2 kW at 17 K temperature difference [TD]) at 2 to 4 m/s. Fan power requirements generally range from 20 to 40 W per kilowatt.

The type of fan depends primarily on static pressure and unit shape requirements. Propeller fans are well suited to units with a low static-pressure drop and free air discharge. Fan blade speeds are selected in the range of 515 to 1750 rpm (1140 rpm is common). Direct-drive propeller fans up to 900 mm in diameter are used in single and multiple assemblies in virtually all sizes of condenser units. Because of the propeller fan's low starting torque requirements, the most common is a permanent split-capacitor (PSC) fractional horsepower motor, having internal inherent protection. These motors are most commonly used up to about 0.5 kW, with shaded-pole motors used in the smallest sizes. Larger motors are generally polyphase induction or synchronous for the lowest-speed fans. In outdoor upward-blow applications, special attention must be paid to

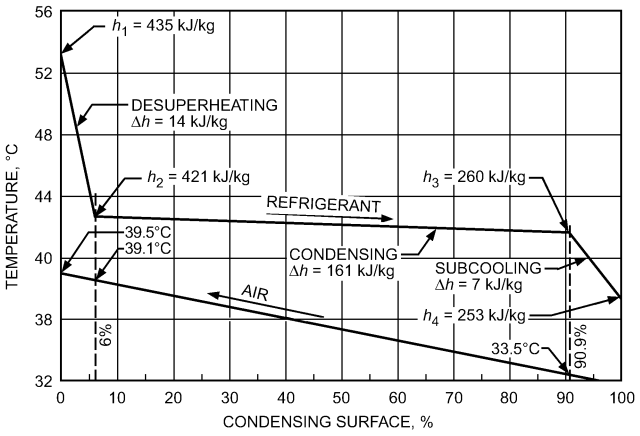


Fig. 6 Temperature and Enthalpy Changes in Air-Cooled Condenser with R-134a

motor thrust bearing selection and to weather protection. When the fan blade is positioned above a vertically installed motor, a shaft-mounted slinger disk is sometimes supplied to further protect the motor and its bearings. In industrial applications, totally enclosed weather-resistant motors are sometimes used.

For free air discharge, direct-drive propeller fans are more efficient than centrifugal fans. A belt drive arrangement on propeller and centrifugal fan(s) offers more flexibility but usually requires greater maintenance, and is used most frequently on centrifugal and propeller fans over 900 mm in diameter. Centrifugal fans are used in noise-sensitive applications and/or where significant external air resistance is expected, as with extended ductwork. Vaneaxial fans are often more efficient than centrifugal fans and are frequently used in the largest sizes, although special provision for the weight of the fans, motors, and belt drive must be made. A partially obstructed fan inlet or outlet can drastically increase the noise level. Support brackets close to the fan inlet or partially obstructing the fan outlet can noticeably effect fan noise and efficiency.

2.3 HEAT TRANSFER AND PRESSURE DROP

In condensers, heat is transferred by (1) desuperheating, (2) condensing, and (3) subcooling. Figure 6 shows the changes of state of R-134a passing through an air-cooled condenser coil and the corresponding temperature change of the cooling air as it passes through the coil. Desuperheating and subcooling zones vary from 5 to 10% of the total heat transfer, depending on the entering gas and leaving liquid temperatures, but Figure 6 is typical. Good design usually has full condensing occurring in approximately 85% of the condenser area, based on an azeotropic refrigerant. Generally this happens at a fairly constant temperature, though some drop in saturated condensing temperature through the condenser coil can occur when there is significant pressure drop in the condensing coil.

Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* lists equations for heat transfer coefficients in the single-phase flow sections. For condensation from saturated vapors, one of the best calculation methods is the Shah correlation (Shah 1979, 1981). Also, Ghaderi et al. (1995) reviewed available correlations for condensation heat transfer in smooth and enhanced tubes.

The overall heat transfer coefficient of an air-cooled condenser can be expressed by Equation (5c) in Chapter 23. It is suggested that direct use of experimental testing for extracted coinciding thermal flow resistance data is preferable to the completely theoretical approach.

For optimum vapor desuperheating and liquid subcooling (i.e., inlet and outlet regions of the coil) a cross-counterflow arrangement of refrigerant and air produces the best performance. In the condensing portion (i.e., halfway through the coil core), the latent heat dissipates and the change of state occurs, with a concurrent refrigerant velocity drop. Because of the change of state, the velocity and volume of the refrigerant drop substantially as it becomes a liquid. In general, most air-cooled condenser designs provide an adequate heat transfer surface area and complementary pressure drop to cause the refrigerant to subcool an average of 1 to 3 K before it leaves the condenser coil. The subcooling section may be integrated into the main coil by routing the liquid outlet tubes through coil rows on the air inlet side of the coil. Some manufacturers use "tripod" circuitry, where two or more parallel tubes of the condensing portion are joined to form a single continuing circuit. Overall capacity increases about 0.9% per 1 K subcooling at the same suction and discharge pressure. To ensure proper operation, liquid quality needs to be 100% at the entrance to the evaporator's inlet flow control device.

Proper condenser design also involves calculating pressure drops for the gas and liquid flow areas in the coil. Chapter 5 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describes an estimation of two-phase pressure drop. The overall pressure drop in a typical condenser ranges from 0.6 to 2.2 K equivalent saturated temperature change.

2.4 CONDENSERS REMOTE FROM COMPRESSOR

Remote air-cooled condensers are used for refrigeration and air conditioning from less than 2 to over 1750 kW. Larger systems use multiple condensers. Larger air-cooled condensers with multiple individual circuits are used when the installation has an array of independent refrigeration systems (e.g., supermarkets). The most common coil-fan arrangements are horizontal coils with upflow air (top discharge), and vertical coil with horizontal airflow (front discharge). The choice of design depends primarily on the intended application and the surroundings.

Refrigerant piping and electrical wiring are the interconnections between the compressor and remote condenser unit. Receivers are most often installed close to the compressor and not the condenser. When selecting installation points for any high-side equipment, major concerns include direct sunlight (high solar load), summer and winter conditions, prevailing wind, elevation differences, and length of piping runs. Recirculated condenser air is a common cause of excessive air temperatures entering the condenser and usually results from a poor choice in locating the condenser, and/or badly accommodating its airflow pattern.

2.5 CONDENSERS AS PART OF CONDENSING UNIT

When the condenser coil is included with the compressor as a packaged assembly, it is called a condensing unit. Condenser units are further categorized as indoor or outdoor units, depending on rain protection, electrical controls, and code approvals. Factory-assembled condensing units consist of one or more compressors, a condenser coil, electrical controls in a panel, a receiver, shutoff valves, switches, and sometimes other related units. Precharged interconnecting refrigerant lines to and from the evaporator may be offered as a kit with smaller units. Open, semihermetic, or full-hermetic compressors are used for single or parallel (multiplexing) piping connections, in which case an accumulator, oil separator, and its crankcase oil return is likely to be included in the package. Indoor units lack weather enclosures, allowing easy access for service to all components; outdoor unit access is obtained by removing cabinet panels or opening hinged covers.

Noise is a major concern in both the design and installation of condensing units, mainly because of the compressor. The following can be done to reduce unwanted sound:

- Avoid a straight-line path from the compressor to the listener.
- Use acoustical material inside the cabinet and to envelop the compressor. Streamline air passages as much as possible. Use top-mounted, vertical air discharge.
- Cushion or suspend the compressor on a suitable base.
- Use a lighter-gage base rather than a heavier one to minimize vibration transmission to other panels.
- Where possible, ensure that natural frequencies of panels and refrigerant lines are different from basic compressor and fan frequencies.
- Avoid refrigerant lines with many bends, which are more likely to produce numerous pulsation forces and natural frequencies that cause audible sounds.
- Be aware that a condenser with a very low refrigerant pressure drop may have one or two passes resonant with the compressor discharge pulsations.
- Use wire basket fan assembly supports to help isolate noise and vibration.
- Fan selection is important; steeply pitched propeller blades and unstable centrifugal fans can be serious noise producers.
- Fan noise is more objectionable at night. Because air temperatures are generally lower at night, fan speed can usually be reduced then to reduce noise levels without negatively affecting performance.
- Design to avoid fan and compressor short-cycling.

See Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information on noise and vibration control.

2.6 WATER-COOLED VERSUS AIR-COOLED CONDENSING

Where small units (less than 2.25 kW) are used and abundant low-cost water is available, both first and operating costs may be lower for water-cooled equipment. Air-cooled equipment generally requires up to a 20% larger compressor and/or longer run time, thus increasing costs. When comparing systems, operation and maintenance of the complete system as well as local conditions need to be considered. Chronic water shortages can affect selection. When cooling towers are used to produce condenser cooling water, the initial cost of water cooling may be higher. Also, the lower operating cost of water cooling may be offset by cooling tower pump, and maintenance costs. Water-cooled condensers are discussed in detail at the beginning of this chapter.

2.7 TESTING AND RATING

Condenser and condensing unit manufacturers specify, select, and test motor and fan combinations as complete assemblies for specific published capacities. Test measurements of capacity should be made in accord with ASHRAE *Standard* 20. Other common tests by manufacturers include motor winding and bearing temperature rise during highest ambient operating conditions, duty cycling at lowest ambient, and mounting positions and noise amplitude. To ensure user safety, most condenser coil designs are submitted for listing by Underwriters Laboratories.

Condensers are rated in terms of total heat rejection (THR), which is the total heat removed in desuperheating, condensing, and subcooling the refrigerant. This value is the product of the mass flow of the refrigerant and the difference in enthalpies of the refrigerant vapor entering and the liquid leaving the condenser coil.

A condenser may also be rated in terms of net refrigeration effect (NRE) or net heat rejection (NHR), which is the total heat rejection less the heat of compression added to the refrigerant in the compressor.

Table 1 Net Refrigeration Effect Factors for Reciprocating Compressors Used with Air-Cooled and Evaporative Condensers

Saturated Suction Temperature, °C	Condensing Temperature, °C					
	30	35	40	45	50	55
Open Compressors[a,b]						
–40	0.71	0.69	0.67	0.65	0.62	0.60
–30	0.76	0.74	0.72	0.70	0.68	0.65
–20	0.81	0.78	0.76	0.74	0.72	0.70
–5	0.85	0.83	0.81	0.79	0.77	0.75
+5	0.91	0.89	0.87	0.85	0.83	0.81
Sealed Compressors[a]						
–40	0.55	0.53	0.51	0.49	0.47	0.44
–30	0.64	0.62	0.60	0.58	0.54	0.49
–20	0.71	0.69	0.67	0.64	0.60	0.56
–5	0.77	0.75	0.73	0.71	0.68	0.64
+5	0.81	0.79	0.77	0.75	0.72	0.70
+10	0.83	0.81	0.79	0.77	0.75	0.73

[a]For R-22, factors are based on 8 K superheat entering the compressor.
[b]For ammonia (R-717), factors are based on 5.5 K superheat.
General notes:
These factors should be used only for air-cooled and evaporative condensers connected to reciprocating compressors.
Condensing temperature is that temperature corresponding to saturation pressure as measured at compressor discharge.
Net refrigeration effect factors are an approximation only. Represent net refrigeration capacity as *approximate only* in published ratings.
For more accurate condenser selection and for condensers connected to centrifugal compressors, use total heat rejection effect of condenser and compressor manufacturer's total rating, which includes heat of compression.

For open compressors, the THR is the sum of the actual power input to the compressor and the NRE. For hermetic compressors, the THR is obtained by adding the NRE to the total motor power input and subtracting any heat losses from the compressor and discharge line surfaces. Surface heat losses are generally 0 to 10% of the power consumed by the motor. All quantities must be expressed in consistent units. Table 1 recommends factors for converting condenser THR ratings to NRE for both open and hermetic reciprocating compressors.

Air-cooled condenser ratings are based on the temperature difference (TD) between the dry-bulb temperature of air entering the coil and the saturated condensing temperature (which corresponds to the refrigerant pressure at the condenser inlet). Typical TD values are 5 to 8 K for low-temperature systems at a –30 to –40°C evaporator temperature, 8 to 11 K for medium-temperature systems at a –7°C evaporator temperature, and 14 to 17 K for air-conditioning systems at a 7°C evaporator temperature. The THR capacity of the condenser is considered proportional to the TD. That is, the capacity at 16 K TD is considered to be double the capacity for the same condenser selected for 8 K TD.

The 1% design day condition is suggested for condenser selection.

The specific design dry-bulb temperature must be selected carefully, especially for refrigeration serving process cooling. An entering air temperature that is higher than expected quickly causes compressor discharge pressure and power to exceed design. This can cause an unexpected shutdown, usually at a time when it can least be tolerated. Also, congested or unusual locations may create entering air temperatures higher than general ambient conditions. Recirculated condenser air is usually the result of a poor choice in locating the installation.

The capacity of an air-cooled condenser equipped with an integral subcooling circuit varies depending on the refrigerant charge. The charge is greater when the subcooling circuit is full of liquid, which increases subcooling. When the subcooling circuit is used for condensing, the refrigerant charge is lower, condensing capacity is greater, and liquid subcooling is reduced. Laboratory testing should be in accordance with ASHRAE *Standard* 20, which requires liquid leaving the condenser coil (under test). Currently no industry certification program exists for air-cooled condensers.

2.8 CONTROL

For a refrigeration system to function properly, the condensing pressure and temperature must be maintained within certain limits. An increase in condensing temperature causes a loss in capacity, requires extra power, and may overload the compressor motor. A condensing pressure that is too low hinders flow through conventional liquid feed devices. This hindrance starves the evaporator and causes a loss of capacity, unbalances the distribution of refrigerant in the evaporator, possibly causes strips of ice to form across the face of a freezer coil, and trips off the unit on low pressure.

Some systems use low-pressure-drop thermostatic expansion valves (balance port TXVs). These low-pressure (usually surge-receiving) systems require an additional means of control to ensure that liquid line subcooled refrigerant enters the expansion valve. Supplemental electronic controls, valves, or, at times, liquid pumps are included. This flow control equipment is often found on units that operate year-round to provide medium- and low-temperature food processing refrigeration, where a precise temperature must be held.

To prevent excessively low pressure during winter operation, two basic control methods are used: (1) refrigerant-side control and (2) air-side control.

Refrigerant-Side Control. Control on the refrigerant side may be accomplished in the following ways:

- By modulating the amount of active condensing surface available for condensing by flooding the coil with liquid refrigerant. This method requires a receiver and a larger charge of refrigerant. Several valving arrangements give the required amount of flooding to meet the variable needs. Both temperature and pressure actuation are used.
- By going to one-half condenser operation. The condenser is initially designed with two equal parallel sections, each accommodating 50% of the load during normal summer operation. During winter, solenoid or three-way valves block off one condenser section (as well as its pumpdown to suction). This saves the flooding overcharge and also allows shutdown of fans on the inactive condenser side (Figure 7). Similar splits, such as one-third or two-thirds, are also possible. Anticipated load variations, along with climate conditions, usually dictate the preferred split arrangement for each specific installation.

  This split-condenser design has gained popularity, not only for its cold-weather control, but also for its ability to reduce the refrigerant charge. Part-load operating conditions also benefit when using a split condenser.

Air-Side Control. Control on the air side may be accomplished by one of three methods, or a combination of two of them: (1) fan cycling, (2) modulating dampers, and (3) fan speed control. Any airflow control must be oriented so that the prevailing wind does not cause adverse operating conditions.

Fan cycling in response to outdoor ambient temperature eliminates rapid cycling, but is limited to use with multiple fan units or is supplemental to other control methods. A common method for control of a two-fan unit is to cycle only one fan. A three-fan unit may cycle two fans. During average winter conditions, large multifan outdoor condensers have electronic controllers programmed to run the first fan (or pair of fans) continuously, at least at low fan speed. The cycle starts with the fan(s) closest to the refrigerant connecting piping as the first fan(s) on, last fan(s) off. The remaining fan(s) may cycle as required on ambient or high-side pressure. Airflow through the condenser may be further reduced by modulating

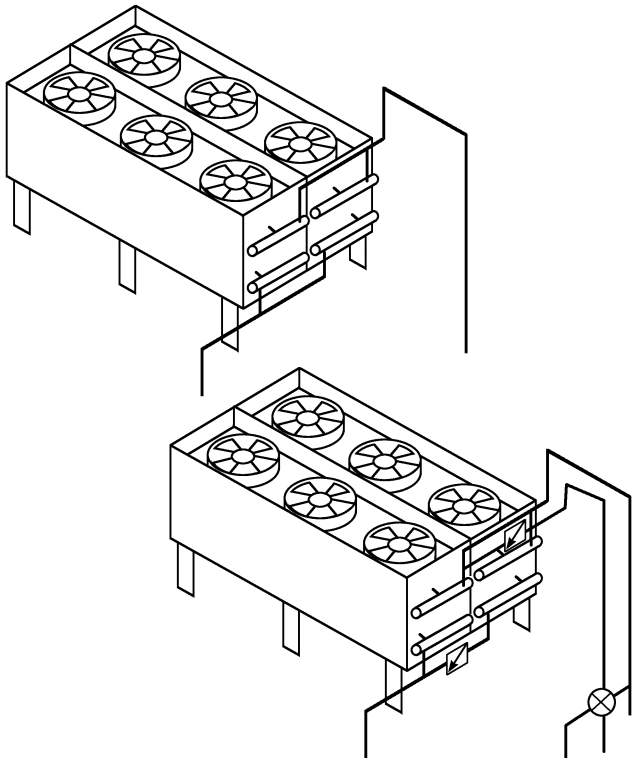


Fig. 7 Equal-Sized Condenser Sections Connected in Parallel and for Half-Condenser Operation During Winter

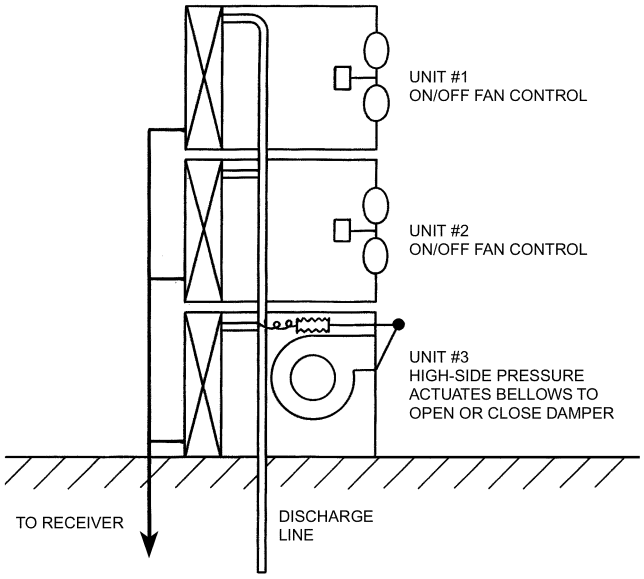


Fig. 8 Unit Condensers Installed in Parallel with Combined Fan Cycling and Damper Control

airflow through the uncontrolled fan section, either by controlling the speed of some or all motors, or by dampers on either the air intake or discharge side (Figure 8).

In multiple, direct-drive motor-propeller arrangements, idle (off-cycle) fans should not be allowed to rotate backward; otherwise, air will short-circuit through them. Motor starting torque may be insufficient to overcome this reverse rotation. To eliminate this problem, designs for large units incorporate baffles to separate each fan assembly into individual compartments.

Air dampers controlled in response to either receiver pressure, ambient conditions, or liquid temperatures are also used to control compressor head pressure. These devices throttle airflow through the condenser coil from 100% to zero. Motors that drive propeller fans for such an application should have a flat power characteristic or should be fan-cooled so they do not overheat when the damper is nearly closed.

Fan speed can also be used to control compressor pressure. Because fan power increases in proportion to the cube of fan speed, energy consumption can be reduced substantially by slowing the fan at low ambient temperatures and during part-load operation. Solid-state controls can modulate frequency along with voltage to vary the speed of synchronous motors. Two-speed fan motors also produce energy savings. Chapter 45 has more information on speed control.

Parallel operation of condensers, especially with capacity control devices, requires careful design. Connecting only identical condensers in parallel reduces operational problems. (The section on Multiple-Condenser Installations has further information. Figures 13 and 14 also apply to air-cooled condensers.)

These control methods maintain sufficient condenser and liquid line pressure for proper expansion valve operation. During off cycles, when the outdoor temperature is lower than that of the indoor space to be conditioned or refrigerated, refrigerant migrates from the evaporator and receiver and condenses in the cold condenser. System pressure drops to what may correspond to the outdoor temperature. On start-up, insufficient feeding of liquid refrigerant to the evaporator, because of low compressor head pressure, causes low-pressure cut-out cycling of the compressor until the suction pressure reaches an operating level above the setting of the low pressurestat. At extremely low outdoor temperatures, system pressure may be below the cut-in point of the pressurestat and the compressor will not start. This difficulty is solved by (1) bypassing the low-pressure switch on start-up, and/or (2) using the condenser isolation method of control.

- **Low-pressure switch bypass.** On system start-up, a time-delay relay may bypass the low-pressure switch for 3 to 5 min to allow head pressure to build up and allow uninterrupted compressor start-up operation.
- **Fan cycle switch.** On system start-up, a high-side pressure-sensing switch can delay condenser fan(s) operation until a minimum preset head pressure is reached.
- **Condenser isolation.** This method uses a check valve arrangement to isolate the condenser. This prevents refrigerant from migrating to the condenser coil during the off cycle.

When the liquid temperature coming from the outdoor condenser is lower than the evaporator operating temperature, consider using a noncondensable-charged thermostatic expansion valve bulb. This type of bulb prevents erratic operation of the expansion valve by eliminating the possibility of condensation of the thermal bulb charge on the head of the expansion valve.

2.9 INSTALLATION AND MAINTENANCE

Installation and maintenance of remote condensers require little labor because of their relatively simple design. Remote condensers are located as close as possible to the compressor, either indoors or outdoors. They may be located above or below the level of the compressor, but always above the level of the receiver. During manufacturing, tubesheets or endplates are fastened to the finned-tube core at each end to complete the coil assembly. These provide a means of mounting the condenser enclosure or, in themselves, can form a part of the condenser unit enclosure. Center supports of similar design also support the condenser cabinet and, on larger units, allow fan section compartmentalizing.

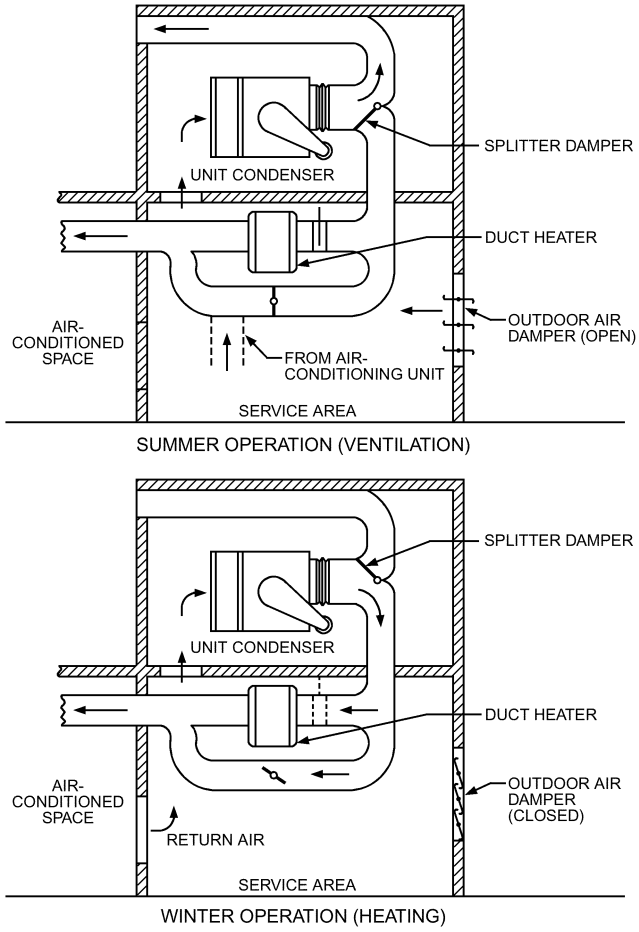


Fig. 9 Air-Cooled Unit Condenser for Winter Heating and Summer Ventilation

Installation and maintenance concerns include the following:

Indoor Condenser. When condensers are located indoors, conduct warm discharge air to the outdoors. An outdoor air intake opening near the condenser is provided and may be equipped with shutters. Indoor condensers can be used for space heating during winter and for ventilation during summer (Figure 9).

Outdoor Installations. In outdoor installations of vertical-face condensers, ensure that prevailing winds blow toward the air intake, or discharge shields should be installed to deflect opposing winds.

Piping. Piping practice with air-cooled condensers is identical to that established by experience with other remote condensers. Size discharge piping to the condenser for a total pressure drop equivalent no more than about 1 K saturated temperature drop. Liquid line drop leg to the receiver should incorporate an adequately sized check valve. Follow standard piping procedures and good piping practices. For pipe sizing, refer to Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Install a pressure tap valve at the highest point in the discharge piping run to facilitate removal of inadvertently trapped noncondensable gases. Purging should only be done with the compressor system off and pressures equalized. *Note*: This is only to be done by qualified personnel having the proper reclaim/recovery equipment as mandated by the appropriate agency, such as the Environmental Protection Agency in the United States.

Receiver. A condenser may have its receiver installed close by, but most often it will be separate and remotely installed. (Most water-cooled systems function without a receiver, because it is an integral part of the water-cooled condenser.) If a receiver is used and located in a comparatively warm ambient temperature, the liquid drain line from the condenser should be sized for a liquid velocity of under 0.5 m/s and designed for gravity drainage as well as for venting to the condenser. The receiver should be equipped with a pressure relief valve assembly that meets applicable codes and discharge requirements, sight glass(es), and positive-action in-and-out shutoff valves. Requirements for such valving are outlined in ASHRAE *Standard* 15.

The receiver's manufacturer can recommend mechanical subcooling and/or reduced refrigerant charge ideas incorporating improved ambient subcooling for condenser coils.

Maintenance. Schedule periodic inspection and lubrication of fan motor and fan bearings. Lube if required, following the instructions found either on the motor nameplate or in the operation manual. Condensers also require periodic removal of lint, leaves, dirt, and other airborne materials from their inlet coil surface by brushing the air entry side of the coil with a long-bristled brush. Washing with a low-pressure water hose or blowing with compressed air is more effectively done from the side opposite the air entry face. A mild cleaning solution is required to remove restaurant grease and other oil films from the fin surface. Indoor condensers in dusty locations, such as processing plants and supermarkets, should have adequate access for unrestricted coil cleaning and fin surface inspection. In all cases, extraneous material on fins reduces equipment performance, shortens operating life, increases running time, and causes more energy use.

When a condenser coil fails (develops leaks), it is usually at the point where the tube is in contact with one of the supporting tubesheets. If not neutralized in some way, these wear points tend to leak after several years of full-time operation. Air-cooled condenser tube fractures are caused mainly by thermal stresses in the coil core, or by excessive vibration. To address this, some manufacturers of larger coils either minimize or eliminate the tube-to-metal contact wear point at tube traverse points of endplates and center supports by substantially oversizing some or all of the endplate and center support tube holes. This design substantially limits refrigerant tube fractures in the coil.

Other potential failure points are at inlet and outlet manifolds. Failure is likely to occur when the manifold or connecting pipe is not adequately supported and/or discharge pulsing is not properly controlled, or when fan unbalance causes vibration.

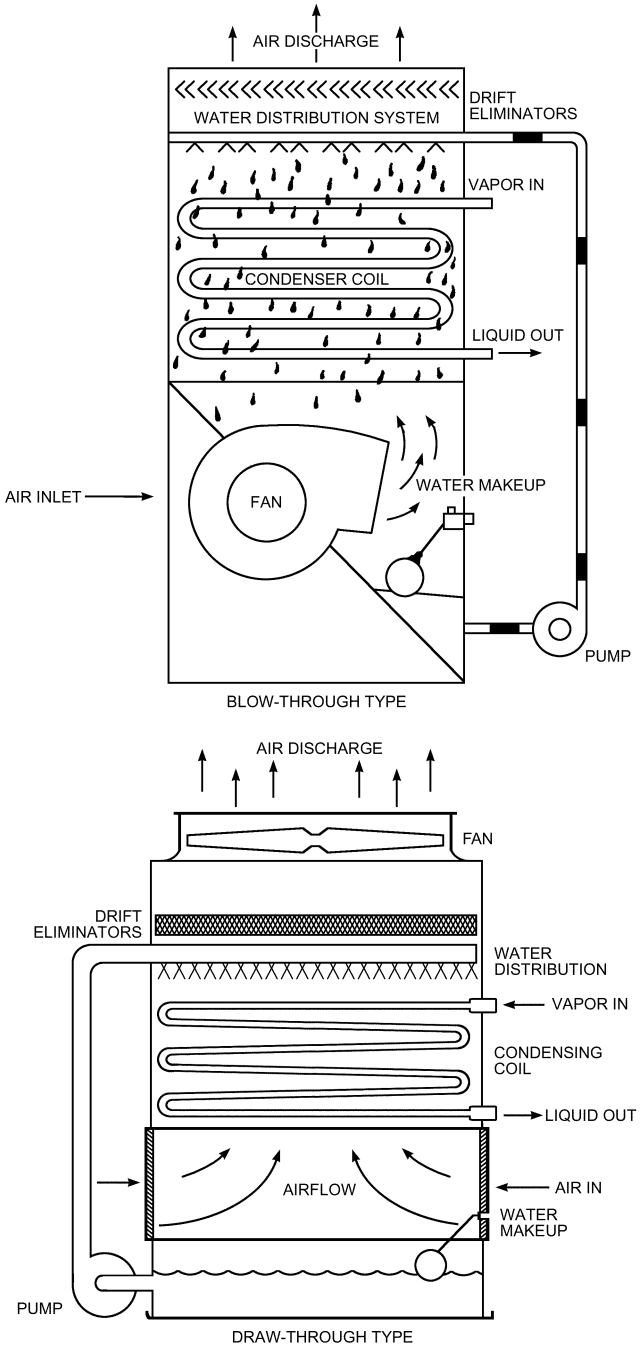


Fig. 10 Functional Views of Evaporative Condenser

3. EVAPORATIVE CONDENSERS

As with water- and air-cooled condensers, evaporative condensers reject heat from a condensing vapor into the environment. In an evaporative condenser, hot, high-pressure vapor from the compressor discharge circulates through a condensing coil that is continually wetted on the outside by a recirculating water system. As seen in Figure 10, air is simultaneously directed over the coil, causing a small portion of the recirculated water to evaporate. This evaporation removes heat from the coil, thus cooling and condensing the vapor.

Evaporative condensers reduce water pumping and chemical treatment requirements associated with cooling tower/refrigerant condenser systems. In comparison with an air-cooled condenser, an evaporative condenser requires less coil surface and airflow to reject the same heat, or alternatively, greater operating efficiencies can be achieved by operating at a lower condensing temperature.

An evaporative condenser can operate at a lower condensing temperature than an air-cooled condenser because the condensing temperature in an air-cooled condenser is determined by the ambient dry-bulb temperature. In the evaporative condenser, heat rejection is limited by the ambient wet-bulb temperature, which is normally 8 to 14 K lower than the ambient dry bulb. Also, evaporative condensers typically provide lower condensing temperatures than the cooling tower/water-cooled condenser because the heat and mass transfer steps (between refrigerant and cooling water and

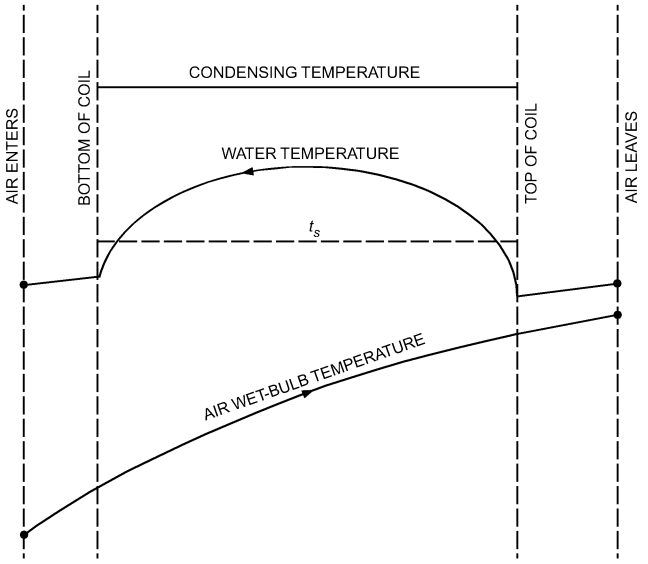


Fig. 11 Heat Transfer Diagram for Evaporative Condenser

between water and ambient air) are more efficiently combined in a single piece of equipment, allowing minimum sensible heating of the cooling water. Evaporative condensers are, therefore, the most compact for a given capacity.

3.1 HEAT TRANSFER

In an evaporative condenser, heat flows from the condensing refrigerant vapor inside the tubes, through the tube wall, to the water film outside the tubes, and then from the water film to the air. Figure 11 shows typical temperature trends in a counterflow evaporative condenser. The driving potential in the first step of heat transfer is the temperature difference between the condensing refrigerant and the surface of the water film, whereas the driving potential in the second step is a combination of temperature and water vapor enthalpy difference between the water surface and air. Sensible heat transfer at the water/air interface occurs because of the temperature gradient, and mass transfer (evaporation) of water vapor from the water/air interface to the airstream occurs because of the enthalpy gradient. Commonly, a single enthalpy driving force between air saturated at the temperature of the water-film surface and the enthalpy of air in contact with that surface is applied to simplify an analytical approach. Exact formulation of the heat and mass transfer process requires considering the two forces simultaneously.

Because evaporative condenser performance cannot be represented solely by a temperature difference or an enthalpy difference, simplified predictive methods can only be used for interpolation of data between test points or between tests of different-sized units, provided that air velocity, water flow, refrigerant velocity, and tube bundle configuration are comparable.

The rate of heat flow from the refrigerant through the tube wall and to the water film can be expressed as

$$q = U_s A(t_c - t_s) \quad (8)$$

where

q = rate of heat flow, W
U_s = overall heat transfer coefficient, W/(m^2 · K)
t_c = saturation temperature at pressure of refrigerant entering condenser, °C
t_s = temperature of water film surface, °C
A = outer surface area of condenser tubes, m^2

The rate of heat flow from the water-air interface to the airstream can be expressed as

$$q = U_c A(h_s - h_e) \quad (9)$$

where

q = heat input to condenser, W
U_c = overall transfer coefficient from water-air interface to airstream, W/(m^2 · K) divided by enthalpy difference Δh in kJ/kg
h_s = enthalpy of air saturated at t_c, kJ/kg
h_e = enthalpy of air entering condenser, kJ/kg

Equations (8) and (9) have three unknowns: U_s, U_c, and t_s (h_s is a function of t_s). Consequently, the solution requires an iterative procedure that estimates one of the three unknowns and then solves for the remaining. This process is further complicated because of some of the more recently developed refrigerant mixtures for which t_c changes throughout the condensing process.

Korenic (1980), Leidenfrost and Korenic (1979, 1982), and Leidenfrost et al. (1980) evaluated heat transfer performance of evaporative condensers by analyzing the internal conditions in a coil. Further work on evaporative condenser performance modeling is under way in the industry.

3.2 CONDENSER CONFIGURATION

Principal components of an evaporative condenser include the condensing coil, fan(s), spray water pump, water distribution system, cold-water sump, drift eliminators, and water makeup assembly.

Coils

Generally, evaporative condensers use condensing coils made from bare pipe or tubing without fins. The high rate of energy transfer from the wetted external surface to the air eliminates the need for an extended surface. Bare coils also sustain performance better because they are less susceptible to fouling and are easier to clean. The high rate of energy transfer from the wetted external surface to the air makes finned coils uneconomical when used exclusively for wet operation. However, partially or wholly finned coils are sometimes used to reduce or eliminate plumes and/or to reduce water consumption by operating the condenser dry during off-peak conditions.

Coils are usually made from steel tubing, copper tubing, iron pipe, or stainless steel tubing. Ferrous materials are generally hot-dip galvanized for exterior protection.

Method of Coil Wetting

The spray water pump circulates water from the cold water sump to the distribution system located above the coil. Water descends through the air circulated by the fan(s), over the coil surface, and eventually returns to the pan sump. The distribution system is designed to completely and continuously wet the full coil surface. Complete wetting ensures the high rate of heat transfer achieved with wet tubes and prevents excessive scaling, which is more likely to occur on intermittently or partially wetted surfaces. Scaling is undesirable because it decreases heat transfer efficiency (which tends to raise the condensing temperature) of the unit. Water lost through evaporation, drift, and blowdown from the cold water sump is replaced through a makeup assembly that typically consists of a mechanical float valve or solenoid valve and float switch combination.

Airflow

All commercially available evaporative condensers use mechanical draft; that is, fans move a controlled flow of air through the unit. As shown in Figure 10, these fans may be on the air inlet side (forced draft) or the air discharge side (induced draft). The type of fan selected, centrifugal or axial, depends on external pressure needs, energy requirements, and permissible sound levels. In many units, recirculating water is distributed over the condensing coil and flows down to the collecting basin, counterflow to the air flowing up through the unit.

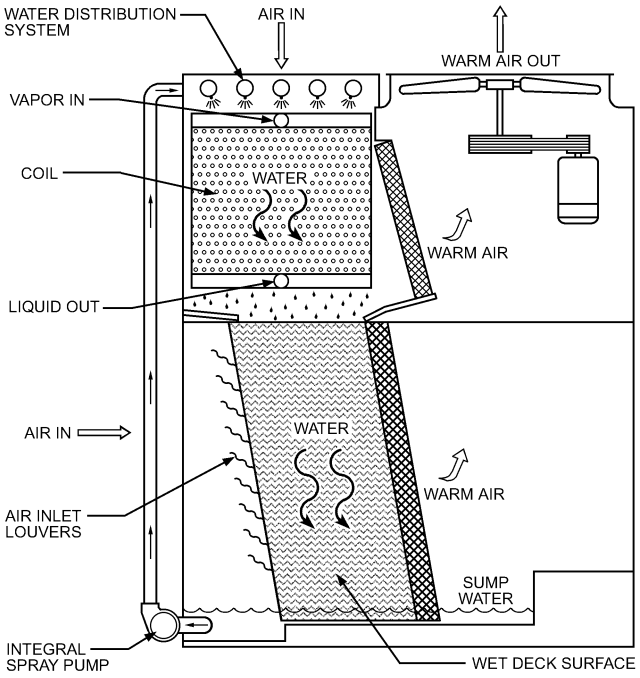


Fig. 12 Combined Coil/Fill Evaporative Condenser

In an alternative configuration (Figure 12) a cooling tower fill augments the condenser's thermal performance. In this unit, one airstream flows down over the condensing coil, parallel to the recirculating water, and exits horizontally into the fan plenum. The recirculating water then flows down over cooling tower fill, where it is further cooled by a second airstream before it is reintroduced over the condenser coil.

Drift eliminators strip most water droplets from the discharge airstream, but some escape as drift. The rate of drift loss from an evaporative condenser is a function of unit configuration, eliminator design, airflow rate through the evaporative condenser, and water flow rate. Generally, an efficient eliminator design can reduce drift loss to a range of 0.001 to 0.2% of the water circulation rate. If the air inlet is near the sump, louvers or deflectors may be installed to prevent water from splashing from the unit.

3.3 CONDENSER LOCATION

Most evaporative condensers are located outdoors, frequently on the roofs of machine rooms. They may also be located indoors and ducted to the outdoors. Generally, centrifugal-fan models must be used for indoor applications to overcome the static resistance of the duct system.

Evaporative condensers installed outdoors can be protected from freezing in cold weather by a remote sump arrangement in which the water and pump are located in a heated space that is remote from the condensers (Figure 13). Piping is arranged so that whenever the pump stops, all the water drains back into the sump to prevent freezing. Where remote sumps are not practical, reasonable protection can be provided by sump heaters, such as electric immersion heaters, steam coils, or hot-water coils. Water pumps and lines must also be protected, for example with electric heat-tracing tape and insulation.

Where the evaporative condenser is ducted to the outdoors, moisture from the warm saturated air can condense in condenser discharge ducts, especially if the ducts pass through a cool space. Some condensation may be unavoidable even with short, insulated ducts. In such cases, the condensate must be drained. Also, in these ducted applications, the drift eliminators must be highly effective.

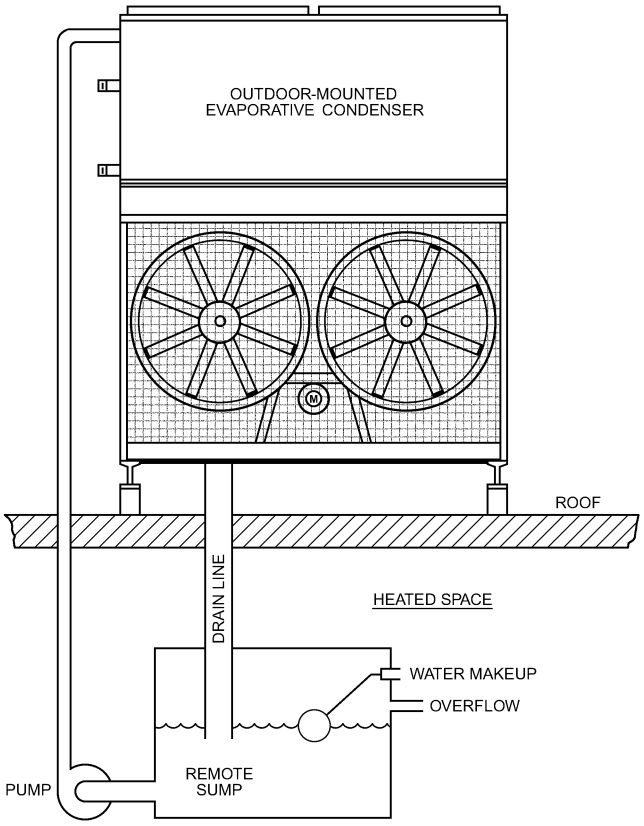


Fig. 13 Evaporative Condenser Arranged for Year-Round Operation

3.4 MULTIPLE-CONDENSER INSTALLATIONS

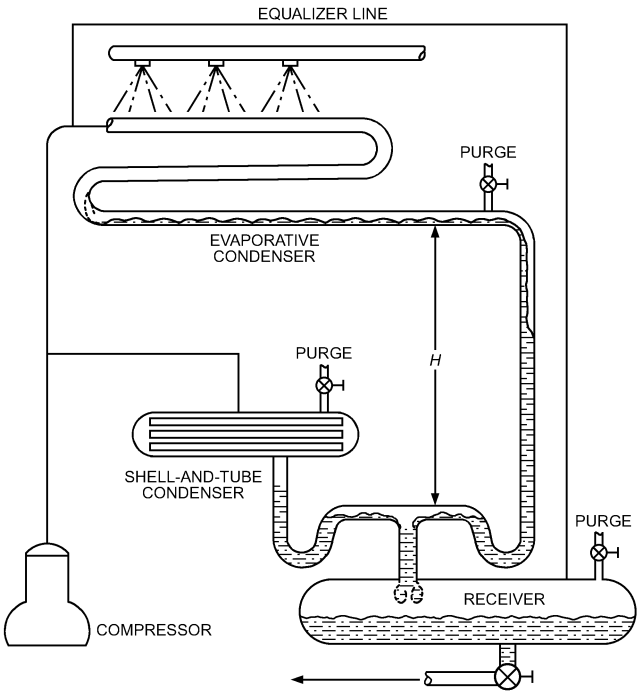
Large refrigeration plants may have several evaporative condensers connected in parallel with each other or with shell-and-tube condensers. In these systems, unless all condensers have the same refrigerant-side pressure drop, condensed liquid refrigerant will flood back into the condensing coils of those condensers with the highest pressure loss. Also, in periods of light load when some condenser fans are off, liquid refrigerant will flood the lower coil circuits of the active condensers.

Trapped drop legs, as shown in Figures 14 and 15, provide proper control of such multiple installations. The effective height H of drop legs must equal the pressure loss through the condenser at maximum loading. Particularly in cold weather, when condensing pressure is controlled by shutting down some condenser fans, active condensers may be loaded considerably above nominal rating, with higher pressure losses. The height of the drop leg should be great enough to accommodate these greater design loads.

3.5 RATINGS

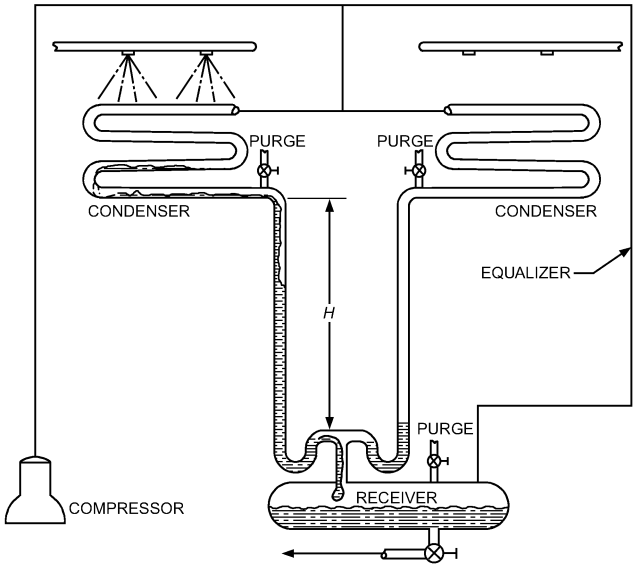
Heat rejected from an evaporative condenser is generally expressed as a function of the saturated condensing temperature and entering air wet bulb. The type of refrigerant has considerable effect on ratings; this effect is handled by separate tables (or curves) for each refrigerant, or by a correction factor when the difference is small.

Evaporative condensers are commonly rated in terms of total heat rejection when condensing a particular refrigerant at a specific condensing temperature and entering air wet-bulb temperature. Many



Pressure created by fluid height (*H*) above trap must be greater than internal resistance of condenser. Note purge connections at both condensers and receiver.

Fig. 14 Parallel Operation of Evaporative and Shell-and-Tube Condenser



Each condenser can operate independently. Height (*H*) above trap, for either condenser, must be not less than internal resistance of condenser. Note purge connections at both condensers and receiver.

Fig. 15 Parallel Operation of Two Evaporative Condensers

manufacturers also provide alternative ratings in terms of evaporator load for a given refrigerant at a specific combination of saturated suction temperature and condensing temperature. These ratings include an assumed value for heat of compression, typically based on an open, reciprocating compressor, and should only be used for that type of unit. Where another type of compression equipment is used, such as a gas-cooled hermetic and semihermetic compressor, the total power input to the compressor(s) should be added to the evaporator load and this value should be used to select the condenser.

Rotary screw compressors use oil to lubricate moving parts and provide a seal between the rotors and the compressor housing. This oil is subsequently cooled either in a separate heat exchanger or by refrigerant injection. In the former case, the amount of heat removed from the oil in the heat exchanger is subtracted from the sum of the refrigeration load and compressor brake power to obtain the total heat rejected by the evaporative condenser. When liquid injection is used, the total heat rejection is the sum of the refrigeration load and brake power. Heat rejection rating data together with any ratings based on refrigeration capacity should be included.

3.6 DESUPERHEATING COILS

A desuperheater is an air-cooled finned coil, usually installed in the discharge airstream of an evaporative condenser (Figure 16). Its primary function is to increase condenser capacity by removing some of the superheat from the discharge vapor before the vapor enters the wetted condensing coil. The amount of superheat removed is a function of the desuperheater surface, condenser airflow, and temperature difference between the refrigerant and air. In practice, a desuperheater is limited to reciprocating compressor ammonia installations where discharge temperatures are relatively high (120 to 150°C).

3.7 REFRIGERANT LIQUID SUBCOOLERS

Refrigerant pressure at the expansion device feeding the evaporator(s) is lower than that in the receiver because of the pressure drop in the liquid line. If the liquid line is long or if the evaporator is above the receiver (which further decreases refrigerant pressure at the expansion device), significant flashing can occur in the liquid line. To avoid flashing where these conditions exist, the liquid refrigerant must be subcooled after it leaves the receiver. The minimum amount of subcooling required is the temperature difference between the condensing temperature and saturation temperature corresponding to the saturation pressure at the expansion device. Subcoolers are often used with halocarbon systems but seldom with ammonia systems for the following reasons:

- Because ammonia has a relatively low liquid density, liquid line static pressure loss is small.
- Ammonia has a very high latent heat; thus, the amount of flash gas resulting from typical pressure loss in the liquid line is extremely small.
- Ammonia is seldom used in a direct-expansion feed system where subcooling is critical to proper expansion valve performance.

One method commonly used to supply subcooled liquid for halocarbon systems places a subcooling coil section in the evaporative condenser below the condensing coil (Figure 17). Depending on the design wet-bulb temperature, condensing temperature, and subcooling coil surface area, the subcooling coil section normally furnishes 5 to 8 K of liquid subcooling. As shown in Figure 17, a receiver must be installed between the condensing coil and subcooling coil to provide a liquid seal for the subcooling circuit.

3.8 MULTICIRCUIT CONDENSERS AND COOLERS

Evaporative condensers and evaporative fluid coolers, which are essentially the same, may be multicircuited to condense different refrigerants or cool different fluids simultaneously, but only if the difference between the condensing temperature and leaving fluid temperature is small. Typical multicircuits (1) condense different

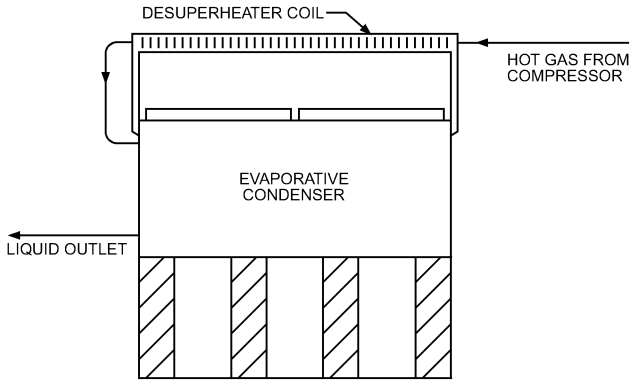


Fig. 16 Evaporative Condenser with Desuperheater Coil

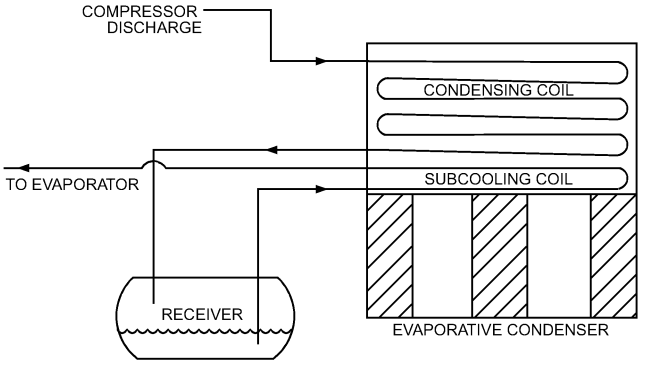


Fig. 17 Evaporative Condenser with Liquid Subcooling Coil

refrigerants found in food market units, (2) condense and cool different fluids in separate circuits (e.g., condensing refrigerant from a screw compressor in one circuit and cooling water or glycol for its oil cooler in another circuit), and (3) cool different fluids in separate circuits such as in many industrial applications where it is necessary to keep the fluids from different heat exchangers in separate circuits.

A multicircuit unit is usually controlled by sensing sump water temperature and using capacity control dampers, fan cycling, or a variable-speed drive to modulate airflow and match unit capacity to the load. Two-speed motors or separate high- and low-speed motors are also used. Sump water temperature has an averaging effect on control. Because all water in the sump is recirculated once every minute or two, its temperature is a good indicator of changes in load.

3.9 WATER TREATMENT

As recirculated water evaporates in an evaporative condenser, dissolved solids in the makeup water continually increase as more water is added. Continued concentration of these dissolved solids can lead to scaling and/or corrosion problems. In addition, airborne impurities and biological contaminants are often introduced into recirculated water. If these impurities are not controlled, they can cause sludge or biological fouling. Simple blowdown (discharging a small portion of the recirculating water to a drain) may be adequate to control scale and corrosion on sites with good-quality makeup water, but it does not control biological contaminants such as *Legionella*. All evaporative condensers should be treated to restrict biological growth and many benefit from chemical treatment to control scale and corrosion. Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* covers water treatment in more detail. Also see ASHRAE *Guideline* 12 for specific recommendations on *Legionella* control. Specific recommendations on water treatment can be obtained from water treatment suppliers.

3.10 WATER CONSUMPTION

For the purpose of sizing makeup water piping, all heat rejected by an evaporative condenser is assumed to be latent heat (approximately 2440 kJ/kg of water evaporated). The heat rejected depends on operating conditions, but can range from 1.2 kW per kilowatt of air conditioning to 1.4 kW/kW of freezer storage. The evaporated water ranges from about 0.5 to 0.6 mL/s per kilowatt (mm^3/J) of refrigeration. In addition, a small amount of water can be lost in the form of drift through the eliminators. With good-quality makeup water, bleed rates may be as low as one-quarter to one-half the evaporation rate, and total water consumption would range from 0.6 mm^3 per J for air conditioning to 0.9 mm^3 per J for refrigeration.

3.11 CAPACITY MODULATION

To ensure operation of expansion valves and other refrigeration components, extremely low condensing pressures must be avoided. Capacity can be controlled in response to condensing pressure on single-circuit condensers and in response to the temperature of the spray water on multicircuited condensers. Means of controlling capacity include (1) intermittent fan operation; (2) a modulating damper in the airstream to reduce the airflow (centrifugal fan models only); and (3) fan speed control using variable-speed motors and/or drives, two-speed motors, or additional lower-power pony motors (small modular motors on the same shaft). Two-speed fan motors usually operate at 100 and 50% fan speed, which provides 100% and approximately 60% condenser capacity, respectively. Pony motors also provide some redundancy in case one motor fails. With the fans off and the water pump operating, condenser capacity is approximately 10%.

Often, a two-speed fan motor or supplementary (pony) motor that operates the fan at reduced speed can provide sufficient capacity control, because condensing pressure seldom needs to be held to a very tight tolerance other than to maintain a minimum condensing pressure to ensure refrigerant liquid feed pressure for the low-pressure side and/or sufficient pressure for hot-gas defrost requirements. For applications requiring close control of condensing pressure, virtually infinite capacity control can be provided by using frequency-modulating controls to control fan motor speed. These controls may also be justified economically because they save energy and extend the life of the fan and drive assembly compared to fan cycling with two-speed control. However, special concerns and limitations are associated with their use, which are discussed in Chapter 45.

Modulating air dampers also offer closer control on condensing pressure, but they do not offer as much fan power reduction at part load as fan speed control. Water pump cycling for capacity control is not recommended because the periodic drying of the tube surface promotes scale build-up.

The designer should research applicable codes and standards when applying evaporative condensers. Most manufacturers provide sound level information for their equipment. Centrifugal fans are inherently quieter than axial fans, but axial fans generally have a lower power requirement for a given application. Low-speed operation and multistaging usually lowers sound levels of condensers with axial fans. In some cases, factory-supplied sound attenuators may need to be installed.

3.12 PURGING

Refrigeration systems operating below atmospheric pressure and systems that are opened for service may require purging to remove

air that causes a high condensing pressure. With the system operating, purging should be done from the top of the condensing coil outlet connection. On multiple-coil condensers or multiple-condenser installations, one coil at a time should be purged. Purging two or more coils at one time equalizes coil outlet pressures and can cause liquid refrigerant to back up in one or more of the coils, thus reducing operating efficiency.

Noncondensables can be removed from the condenser using a mechanical, automatic operational purge unit for halogenated refrigerants. Additional information on purge units is located in Chapter 43. Manual purging, which involves opening a manual valve and releasing noncondensables (and refrigerant) to the atmosphere, is not acceptable for halogenated refrigerants because environmental laws prohibit intentional venting of refrigerant from the system.

Purging may also be done from the high point of the evaporative condenser refrigerant feed, but it is only effective when the condenser is not operating. During normal operation, noncondensables are dispersed throughout the high-velocity vapor, and excessive refrigerant would be lost if purging were done from this location (see Figures 14 and 15). All codes and ordinances governing discharge, recovery, and recycling of refrigerants must be followed.

3.13 MAINTENANCE

Evaporative condensers are often installed in remote locations and may not receive the routine attention of operating and maintenance personnel. Programmed maintenance is essential, however; consult the manufacturer's operation and maintenance guidelines (often downloadable from their websites). Table 2 shows a typical checklist for evaporative condensers.

Table 2 Typical Maintenance Checklist

Maintenance Item	Frequency
1. Check fan and motor bearings, and lubricate if necessary. Check tightness and adjustment of thrust collars on sleeve-bearing units and locking collars on ball-bearing units.	Q
2. Check belt tension.	M
3. Clean strainer. If air is extremely dirty, strainer may need frequent cleaning.	W
4. Check, clean, and flush sump, as required.	M
5. Check operating water level in sump, and adjust makeup valve, if required.	W
6. Check water distribution, and clean as necessary.	W
7. Check bleed water line to ensure it is operative and adequate as recommended by manufacturer.	M
8. Check fans and air inlet screens and remove any dirt or debris.	D
9. Inspect unit carefully for general preservation and cleanliness, and make any needed repairs immediately.	R
10. Check operation of controls such as modulating capacity control dampers.	M
11. Check operation of freeze control items such as pan heaters and their controls.	Y
12. Check the water treatment system for proper operation.	W
13. Inspect entire evaporative condenser for spot corrosion. Treat and refinish any corroded spot.	Y

D = Daily; W = Weekly; M = Monthly; Q = Quarterly; Y = Yearly; R = As required.

3.14 TESTING AND RATING

If state or local codes do not take precedence, design pressures, materials, welding, tests, and relief devices should be in accordance with the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*, Section VIII, Division 1. Evaporative condensers are typically exempt, however, from the ASME Code on the basis of Item (c) of the Scope of the Code, which states that if the inside diameter of the condenser shell is 150 mm or less, it is not governed by the Code. (Coils can be built in compliance with ASME *Code* B31.5, however.) Other rating and testing standards include

- ASHRAE *Standard* 15, Safety Standard for Refrigeration Systems
- ASHRAE *Standard* 64, Methods of Testing Remote Mechanical-Draft Evaporative Refrigerant Condensers
- AHRI *Standard* 490, Remote Mechanical-Draft Evaporative Refrigerant Condensers

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CHAPTER 40

COOLING TOWERS

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MOST air-conditioning systems and industrial processes generate heat that must be removed and dissipated. Water is commonly used as a heat transfer medium to remove heat from refrigerant condensers or industrial process heat exchangers. In the past, this was accomplished by drawing a continuous stream of water from a utility water supply or a natural body of water, heating it as it passed through the process, and then discharging the water directly to a sewer or returning it to the body of water. Water purchased from utilities for this purpose has become prohibitively expensive because of higher water supply and disposal costs. Similarly, cooling water drawn from natural sources is relatively unavailable because the ecological disturbance caused by the increased temperature of discharge water has become unacceptable.

Air-cooled heat exchangers cool water by rejecting heat directly to the atmosphere, but the first cost and fan energy consumption of these devices are high, and the plan area required is relatively large. They can economically cool water to within approximately 11 K of the ambient dry-bulb temperature: too high for the cooling water requirements of most refrigeration systems and many industrial processes.

Cooling towers overcome most of these problems and therefore are commonly used to dissipate heat from refrigeration, air-conditioning, and industrial process systems. The water consumption rate of a cooling tower system is only about 5% of that of a once-through system, making it the least expensive system to operate with purchased water supplies. Additionally, the amount of heated water discharged (**blowdown**) is very small, so the ecological effect is greatly reduced. Lastly, cooling towers can cool water to within 2 to 3 K of the ambient wet-bulb temperature, which is always lower than the ambient dry-bulb, or approximately 20 K lower than can air-cooled systems of reasonable size (in the 880 to 1760 kW range). This lower temperature improves the efficiency of the overall system, thereby reducing energy use significantly and increasing process output.

1. PRINCIPLE OF OPERATION

A cooling tower cools water by a combination of heat and mass transfer. Water to be cooled is distributed in the tower by spray nozzles, splash bars, or film-type fill, which exposes a very large water surface area to atmospheric air. Atmospheric air is circulated by (1) fans, (2) convective currents, (3) natural wind currents, or (4) induction effect from sprays. A portion of the water absorbs heat to change from a liquid to a vapor at constant pressure. This heat of vaporization at atmospheric pressure is transferred from the water remaining in the liquid state into the airstream.

Figure 1 shows the temperature relationship between water and air as they pass through a counterflow cooling tower. The curves indicate the drop in water temperature (A to B) and the rise in the air wet-bulb temperature (C to D) in their respective passages through the tower. The temperature difference between the water entering and leaving the cooling tower (A minus B) is the range. For a steady-state system, the range is the same as the water temperature rise through the load heat exchanger, provided the flow rate through the cooling tower and heat exchanger are the same. Accordingly, the range is determined by the heat load and water flow rate, not by the size or thermal capability of the cooling tower.

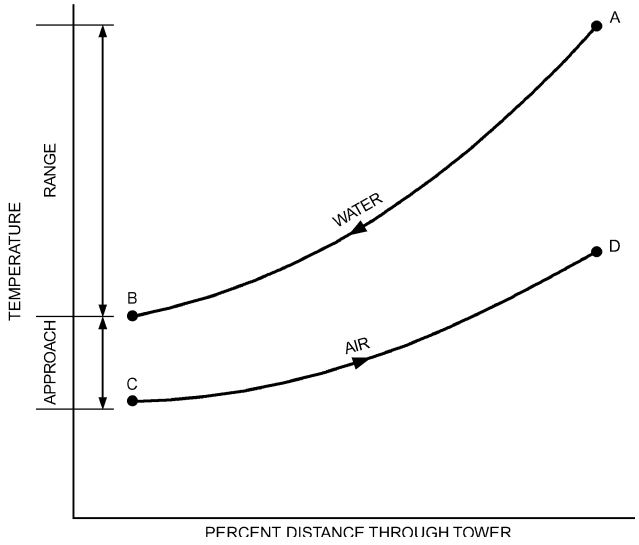

Fig. 1 Temperature Relationship Between Water and Air in Counterflow Cooling Tower

The difference between the leaving water temperature and entering air wet-bulb temperature (B minus C) in Figure 1 is the approach to the wet-bulb or simply the approach of the cooling tower. The approach is a function of cooling tower capability. A larger cooling tower produces a closer approach (colder leaving water) for a given heat load, flow rate, and entering air condition. Therefore, the amount of heat transferred to the atmosphere by the cooling tower is always equal to the heat load imposed on the tower, whereas the temperature level at which the heat is transferred is determined by the thermal capability of the cooling tower and the entering air wet-bulb temperature.

Thermal performance of a cooling tower depends mainly on the entering air wet-bulb temperature. The entering air dry-bulb temperature and relative humidity, taken independently, have an insignificant effect on thermal performance of mechanical-draft cooling towers, but do affect the rate of water evaporation in the cooling tower. A psychrometric analysis of the air passing through a cooling tower illustrates this effect (Figure 2). Air enters at the ambient condition point A, absorbs heat and mass (moisture) from the water, and exits at point B in a saturated condition (at very light loads, the discharge air may

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.6, Cooling Towers and Evaporative Condensers.

not be fully saturated). The amount of heat transferred from the water to the air is proportional to the difference in enthalpy of the air between the entering and leaving conditions ($h_B - h_A$). Because lines of constant enthalpy correspond almost exactly to lines of constant wet-bulb temperature, the change in enthalpy of the air may be determined by the change in wet-bulb temperature of the air.

Air heating (vector AB in Figure 2) may be separated into component AC, which represents the sensible portion of the heat absorbed by the air as the water is cooled, and component CB, which represents the latent portion. If the entering air condition is changed to point D at the same wet-bulb temperature but at a higher dry-bulb temperature, the total heat transfer (vector DB) remains the same, but the sensible and latent components change dramatically. DE represents sensible cooling of air, whereas EB represents latent heating as water gives up heat and mass to the air. Thus, for the same water-cooling load, the ratio of latent to sensible heat transfer can vary significantly.

The ratio of latent to sensible heat is important in analyzing water usage of a cooling tower. Mass transfer (evaporation) occurs only in the latent portion of heat transfer and is proportional to the change in specific humidity. Because the entering air dry-bulb temperature or relative humidity affects the latent to sensible heat transfer ratio, it also affects the rate of evaporation. In Figure 2, the rate of evaporation in case AB ($W_B - W_A$) is less than in case DB ($W_B - W_D$) because the latent heat transfer (mass transfer) represents a smaller portion of the total.

The evaporation rate at typical design conditions is approximately 1% of the water flow rate for each 7 K of water temperature range; however, the average evaporation rate over the operating season is less than the design rate because the sensible component of total heat transfer increases as entering air temperature decreases. The evaporation rate is also directly proportional to the load; this must be taken into account when estimating annual water usage.

In addition to water loss from evaporation, losses also occur because of liquid carryover into the discharge airstream and blowdown to maintain acceptable water quality. Both of these factors are addressed later in this chapter.

2. DESIGN CONDITIONS

The thermal capability of any cooling tower may be defined by the following parameters:

- Entering and leaving water temperatures
- Entering air wet-bulb (and sometimes dry-bulb) temperatures
- Water flow rate

The entering air dry-bulb temperature affects the amount of water evaporated from any evaporative cooling tower. It also affects airflow through hyperbolic towers and directly establishes thermal capability in any indirect contact cooling tower component operating in a dry mode. Variations in tower performance associated with changes in the remaining parameters are covered in the section on Performance Curves.

The thermal capability of a cooling tower used for air conditioning may be expressed in nominal capacity, which is based on heat dissipation of 1.25 kW per kilowatt of evaporator cooling. Nominal cooling capacity is defined as cooling 54 mL/s of water from 35°C to 29.4°C at a 25.6°C entering air wet-bulb temperature. At these conditions, the cooling tower rejects 1.25 kW per kilowatt of evaporator capacity. The historical derivation is based on the assumption that at typical air-conditioning conditions, for every kilowatt of heat picked up in the evaporator, the cooling tower must dissipate an additional 0.25 kW of compressor heat. Newer, high-efficiency compressor systems have significantly reduced the amount of compressor heat generated. For specific applications, nominal capacity ratings are not used, and the thermal performance capability of the cooling tower is usually expressed as a water flow rate at specific operating temperature conditions (entering water temperature, leaving water temperature, entering air wet-bulb temperature).

3. TYPES OF COOLING TOWERS

Two basic types of evaporative cooling devices are used. The **direct-contact** or **open cooling tower** (Figure 3), exposes water directly to the cooling atmosphere, thereby transferring the source heat load directly to the air. A **closed-circuit cooling tower**, involves **indirect contact** between heated fluid and atmosphere (Figure 4), essentially combining a heat exchanger and cooling tower into one relatively compact device.

Of the direct-contact devices, the most rudimentary is a spray-filled cooling tower that exposes water to the air without any heat transfer medium or fill. In this device, the amount of water surface exposed to the air depends on the spray efficiency, and the time of

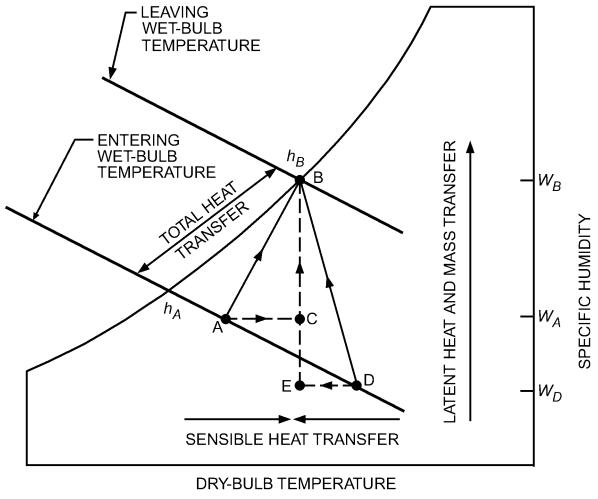

Fig. 2 Psychrometric Analysis of Air Passing Through Cooling Tower

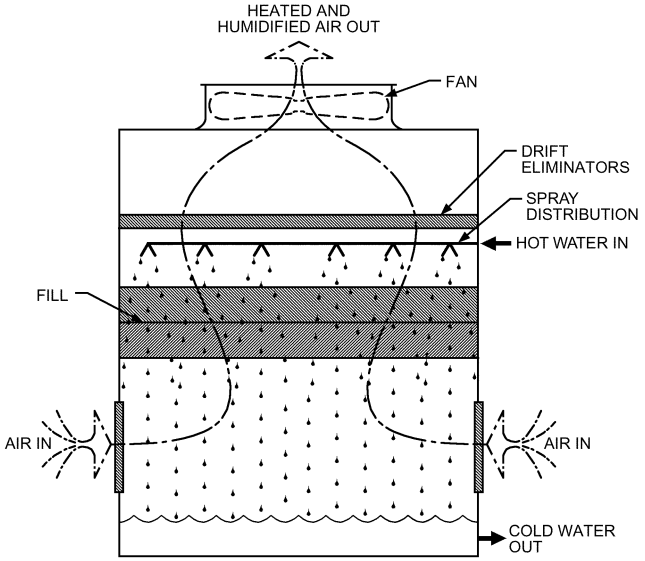

Fig. 3 Direct-Contact or Open Evaporative Cooling Tower

contact depends on the elevation and pressure of the water distribution system.

To increase contact surfaces as well as time of exposure, a heat transfer medium, or fill, is installed below the water distribution system, in the path of the air. The two types of fill in use are splash-type and film-type (Figure 5A). Splash-type fill maximizes contact area and time by forcing the water to cascade through successive elevations of splash bars arranged in staggered rows. Film-type fill

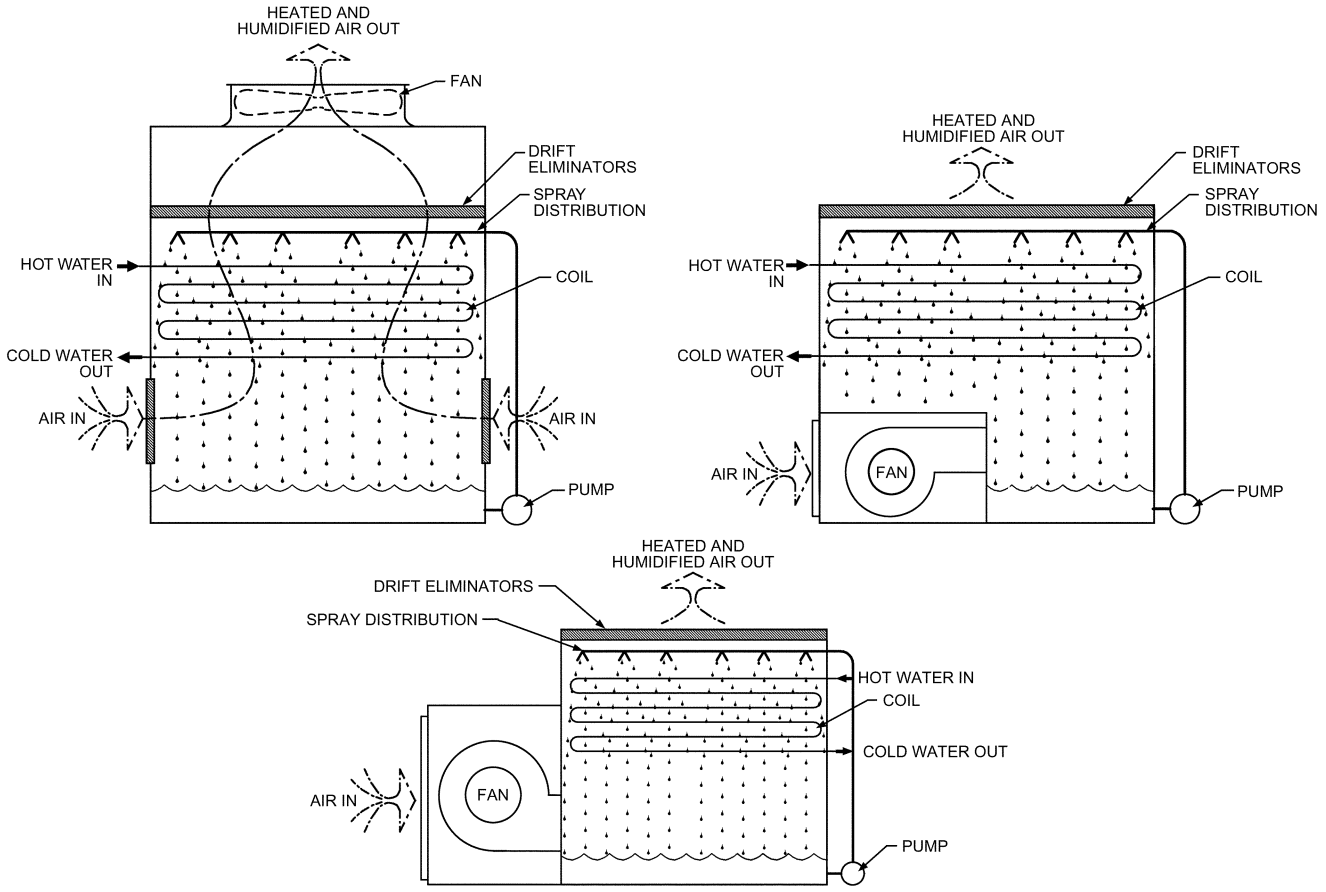

Fig. 4 Indirect-Contact or Closed-Circuit Evaporative Cooling Towers

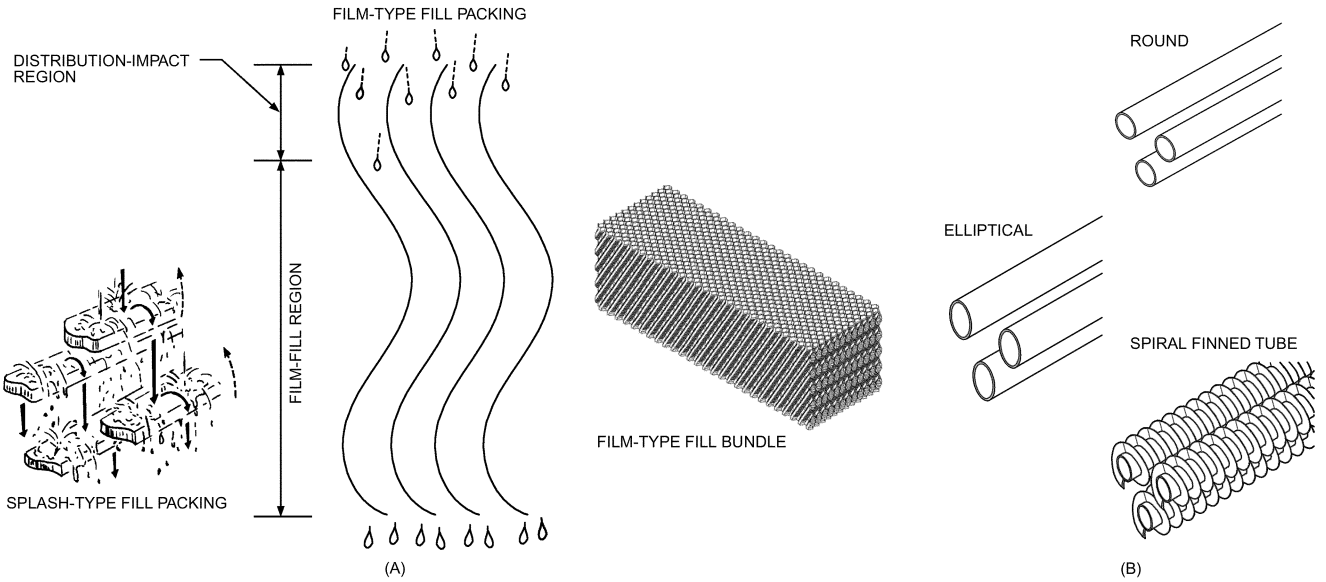

Fig. 5 Types of (A) Fill and (B) Coils

achieves the same effect by causing the water to flow in a thin layer over closely spaced sheets, principally polyvinyl chloride (PVC), that are arranged vertically.

Either type of fill can be used in counterflow and cross-flow cooling towers. For thermal performance levels typically encountered in air conditioning and refrigeration, a tower with film-type fill is usually more compact. However, splash-type fill is less sensitive to initial air and water distribution and, along with specially configured, more widely spaced film-type fills, is preferred for applications that may be subjected to blockage by scale, silt, or biological fouling.

Indirect-contact (closed-circuit) cooling towers contain two separate fluid circuits: (1) an external circuit, in which water is exposed to the atmosphere as it cascades over the tubes of a coil bundle, and (2) an internal circuit, in which the fluid to be cooled circulates inside the tubes of the coil bundle or a pack of corrugated plates. In operation, heat flows from the internal fluid circuit, through the walls of the coil tube or plate, to the external water circuit and then, by heat and mass transfer, to atmospheric air. Because the internal fluid circuit never contacts the atmosphere, this unit can be used to cool fluids other than water and/or to prevent contamination of the primary cooling circuit with airborne dirt and impurities. Some closed-circuit cooling tower designs include cooling tower fill to augment heat exchange in the coil (Figure 6).

Coil Shed Cooling Towers (Mechanical Draft). Coil shed cooling towers usually consist of isolated coil sections (nonventilated) located beneath a conventional cooling tower (Figure 7). Counterflow and cross-flow types are available with either forced- or induced draft fan arrangements. Redistribution water pans at the tower's base may be used to feed cooled water by gravity flow to the tubular heat exchange bundles (coils). These units are similar in function to closed-circuit fluid coolers, except that supplemental fill is always required, and the airstream is directed only through the fill regions of the cooling tower. Often, designs allow water from the fill section to impinge directly on the coil(s). These units are arranged as field-erected, multifan cell towers and are used primarily in industrial process cooling. Modular factory-assembled versions are also available.

Direct-Contact Cooling Towers

Nonmechanical-Draft Cooling Towers. Aspirated by sprays or a differential in air density, these towers do not contain fill and do not use a mechanical air-moving device. The aspirating effect of the water spray, either vertical (Figure 8) or horizontal (Figure 9), induces airflow through the cooling tower in a parallel flow pattern.

Because air velocities for the vertical spray tower (both entering and leaving) are relatively low, such cooling towers are susceptible to adverse wind effects and, therefore, are normally used to satisfy a low-cost requirement when operating temperatures are not critical to the system. Some horizontal spray cooling towers (Figure 9) use high-pressure sprays to induce large air quantities and improve air/water contact. Multispeed or staged pumping systems are normally recommended to reduce energy use in periods of reduced load and ambient conditions.

Chimney (hyperbolic) towers have been used primarily for large power installations, but may be of generic interest (Figure 10). The heat transfer mode may be counterflow, cross-flow, or parallel flow. Air is induced through the cooling tower by the air density differentials that exist between the lighter, heat-humidified chimney air and the outdoor atmosphere. Fill can be splash or film type.

Primary justification of these high first-cost products comes through reduction in auxiliary power requirements (elimination of fan energy), reduced property area, and elimination of recirculation and/or vapor plume interference. Materials used in chimney construction have been primarily steel-reinforced concrete; early timber structures had size limitations.

Mechanical-Draft Cooling Towers. Figure 11 shows five different designs for mechanical-draft (conventional) cooling towers. Fans may be on the inlet air side (forced-draft) or the exit air side (induced-draft). The type of fan selected, either centrifugal or axial, depends on external pressure needs, permissible sound levels, and energy usage requirements. Water is downflow; the air may be upflow (counterflow heat transfer) or horizontal flow (cross-flow heat transfer). Air entry may be through one, two, three, or all four sides of the tower. All four combinations (i.e., forced-draft counterflow, induced-draft counterflow, forced-draft cross-flow, and induced-draft cross-flow) have been produced in various sizes and configurations.

Cooling towers are typically classified as either factory-assembled (Figure 12), where the entire cooling tower or a few large components are factory-assembled and shipped to the site for installation, or field-erected (Figure 13), where the tower is constructed completely on site.

Most factory-assembled cooling towers are of metal construction, usually galvanized steel. Other constructions include stainless steel

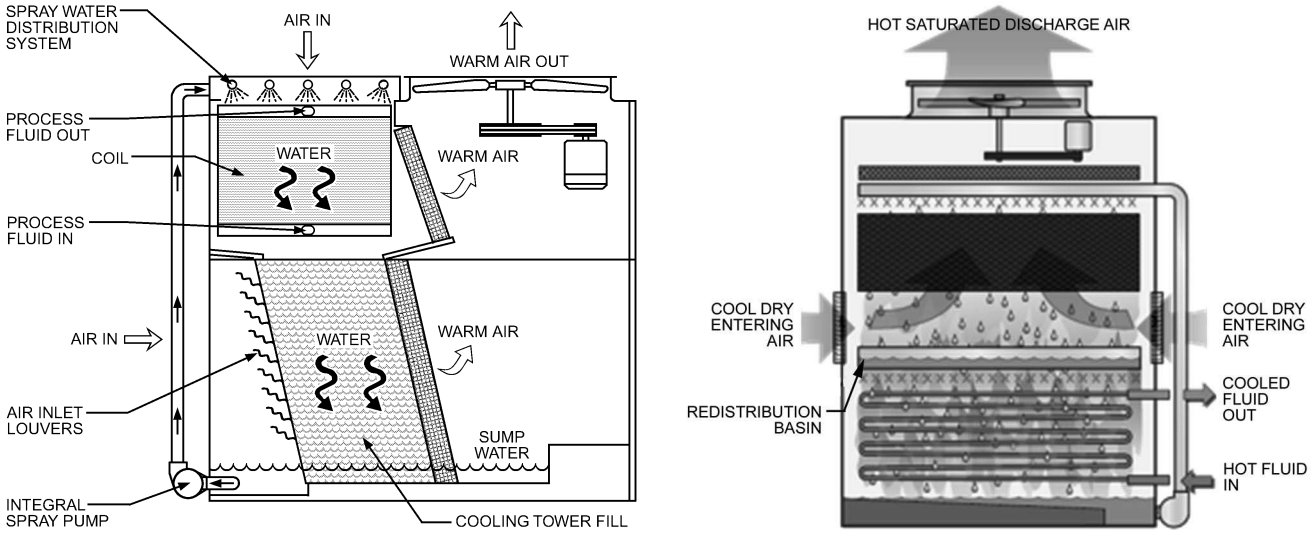

Fig. 6 Combined Flow Coil/Fill Evaporative Cooling Tower

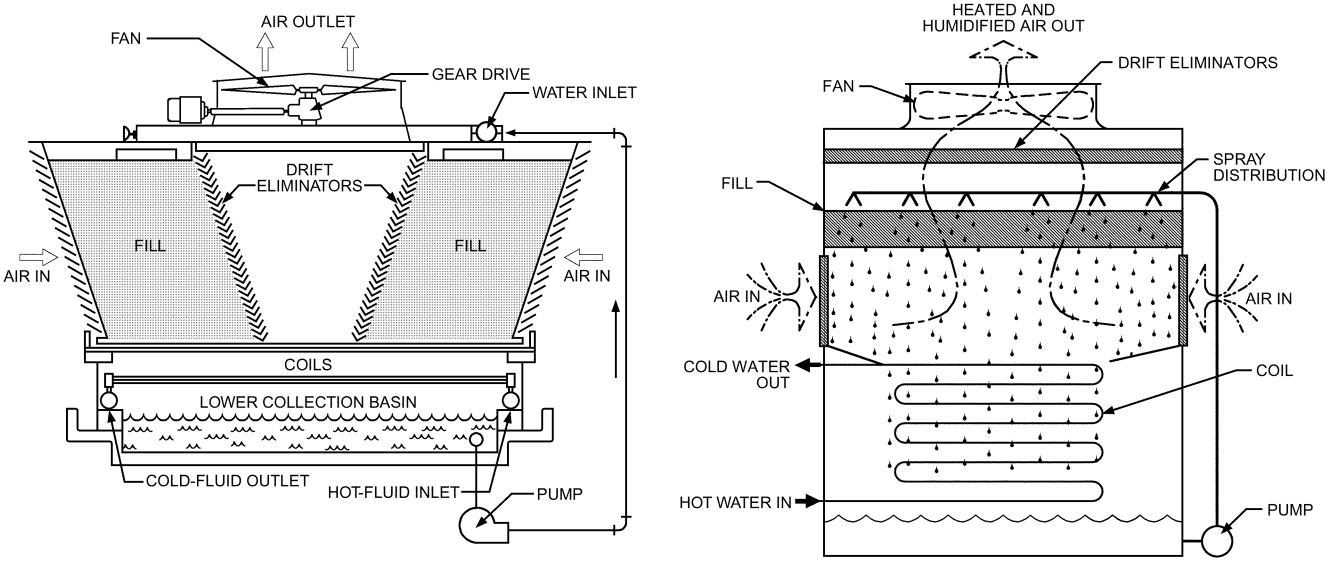

Fig. 7 Coil Shed Cooling Tower

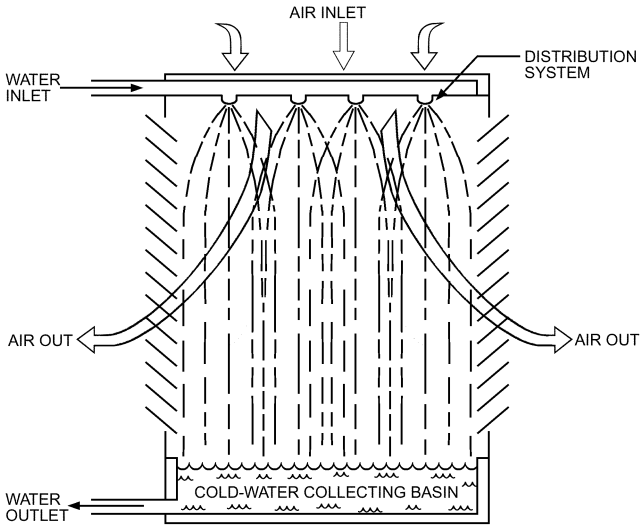

Fig. 8 Vertical Spray Cooling Tower

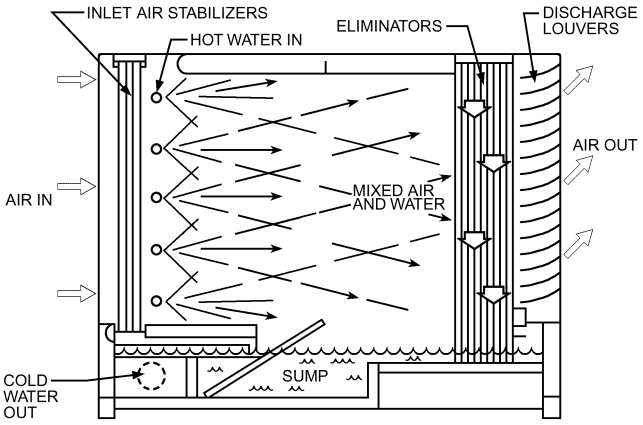

Fig. 9 Horizontal Spray Cooling Tower

and fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) towers and components. Field-erected towers are predominantly framed of preservative-treated Douglas fir or redwood, with FRP used for special components and casing materials. Environmental concerns about cutting timber and wood preservatives leaching into cooling tower water have led to an increased number of cooling towers having FRP structural framing. Field-erected cooling towers may also be constructed of galvanized steel or stainless steel. Coated metals, primarily steel, are also used for complete towers or components. Concrete and ceramic materials are usually restricted to the largest towers (see the section on Materials of Construction).

Special-purpose cooling towers containing a conventional mechanical-draft unit in combination with an air-cooled (finned-tube) heat exchanger are wet/dry cooling towers (Figure 14). They are used for either vapor plume reduction or water conservation. The hot, moist plumes discharged from cooling towers are especially dense in cooler weather. On some installations, limited abatement of these plumes is required to avoid restricted visibility on roadways, on bridges, and around buildings.

A vapor plume abatement cooling tower usually has a relatively small air-cooled component that tempers the leaving airstream to reduce the relative humidity and thereby minimize the fog-generating potential of the tower. Conversely, a water conservation cooling tower usually requires a large air-cooled component to significantly reduce water consumption and provide plume abatement. Some designs can handle heat loads entirely by the nonevaporative air-cooled heat exchanger portion during reduced ambient temperature conditions.

A variant of the wet/dry cooling tower is an evaporatively precooled/air-cooled heat exchanger. It uses an adiabatic saturator (air precooler/humidifier) to enhance summer performance of an air-cooled exchanger, thus conserving water compared to conventional cooling towers (annualized) (Figure 15). Evaporative fill sections usually operate only during specified summer periods, whereas full dry operation is expected below 10 to 20°C dry-bulb ambient conditions. Integral water pumps return the lower basin water to the upper distribution systems of the adiabatic saturators in a manner similar to closed-circuit fluid cooler and evaporative condenser products.

Other Methods of Direct Heat Rejection.

Ponds, Spray Ponds, Spray Module Ponds, and Channels. Heat dissipates from the surface of a body of water by evaporation,

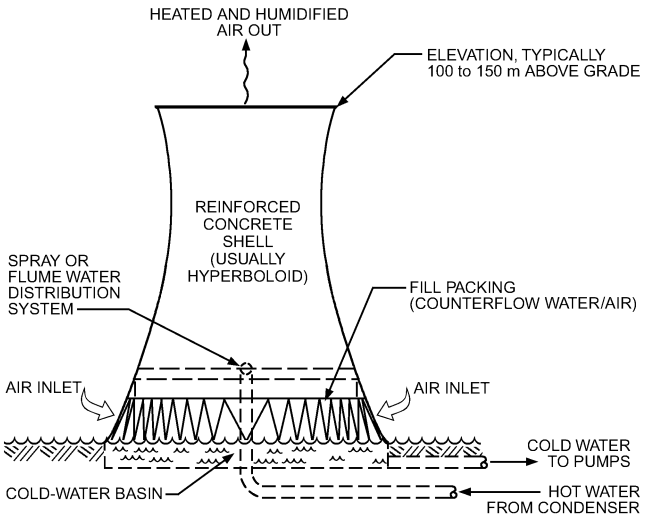

Fig. 10 Hyperbolic Tower

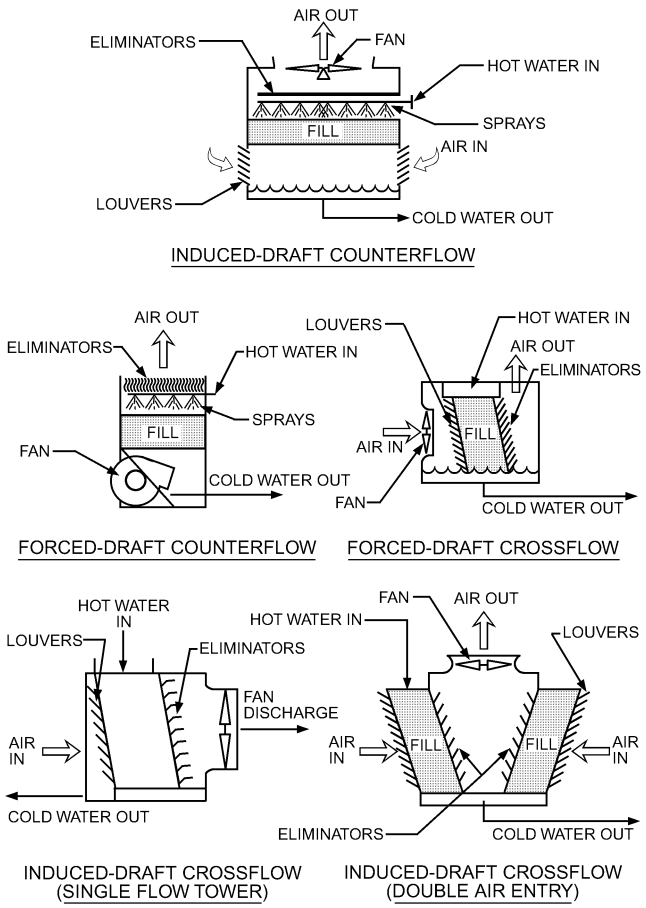

Fig. 11 Conventional Mechanical-Draft Cooling Towers

radiation, and convection. Captive lakes or ponds (artificial or natural) are sometimes used to dissipate heat by natural air currents and wind. This system is usually used in large plants where real estate is not limited.

A pump-spray system above the pond surface improves heat transfer by spraying water in small droplets, thereby extending the water surface and bringing it into intimate contact with the air. Heat

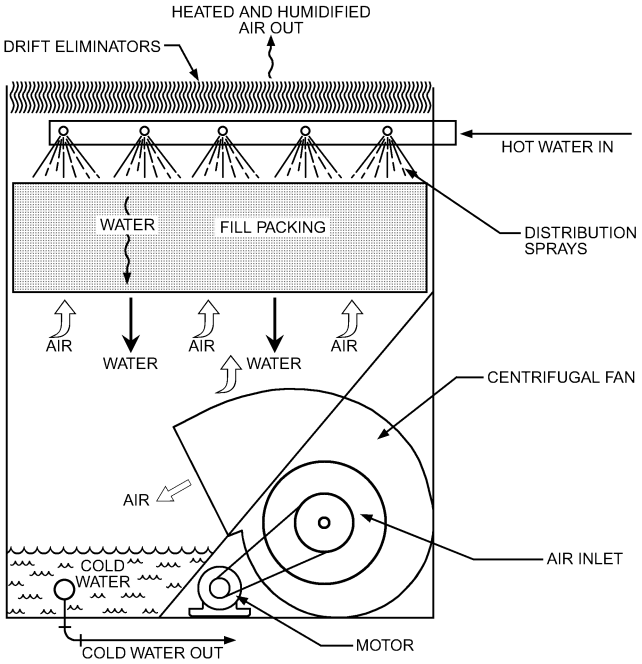

Fig. 12 Factory-Assembled Counterflow Forced-Draft Cooling Tower

transfer is largely the result of evaporative cooling (see the section on Cooling Tower Theory). The system is a piping arrangement using branch arms and nozzles to spray circulated water into the air. The pond acts largely as a collecting basin. Temperature control, real estate demands, limited approach to the wet-bulb temperature, and winter operational difficulties have ruled out the spray pond in favor of more compact and more controllable mechanical- or natural-draft towers.

Empirically derived relationships such as Equation (1) have been used to estimate cooling pond area. However, because of variations in wind velocity and solar radiation as well as the overall validity of the relationship itself, a substantial margin of safety should be added to the result.

$$w_p = \frac{A(0.0887 + 0.07815v)}{h_{fg}} [p_w - p_a] \quad (1)$$

where

w_p = evaporation rate of water, kg/s
A = area of pool surface, m^2
v = air velocity over water surface, m/s
h_{fg} = latent heat required to change water to vapor at temperature of surface water, kJ/kg
p_a = saturation vapor pressure at dew-point temperature of ambient air, kPa
p_w = saturation vapor pressure at temperature of surface water, kPa

Indirect-Contact Cooling Towers

Closed-Circuit Cooling Towers (Mechanical Draft). Both counterflow and cross-flow arrangements are used in forced- and induced-draft fan arrangements. The tubular heat exchangers are typically serpentine bundles, usually arranged for free gravity internal drainage. Pumps are integrated in the product to transport water from the lower collection basin to upper distribution basins or sprays. The internal coils (see Figure 5B) can be constructed from several materials, but galvanized steel, stainless steel, and copper predominate. Closed-circuit cooling towers, which are similar to evaporative condensers (see Chapter 39), are used extensively on water-source heat

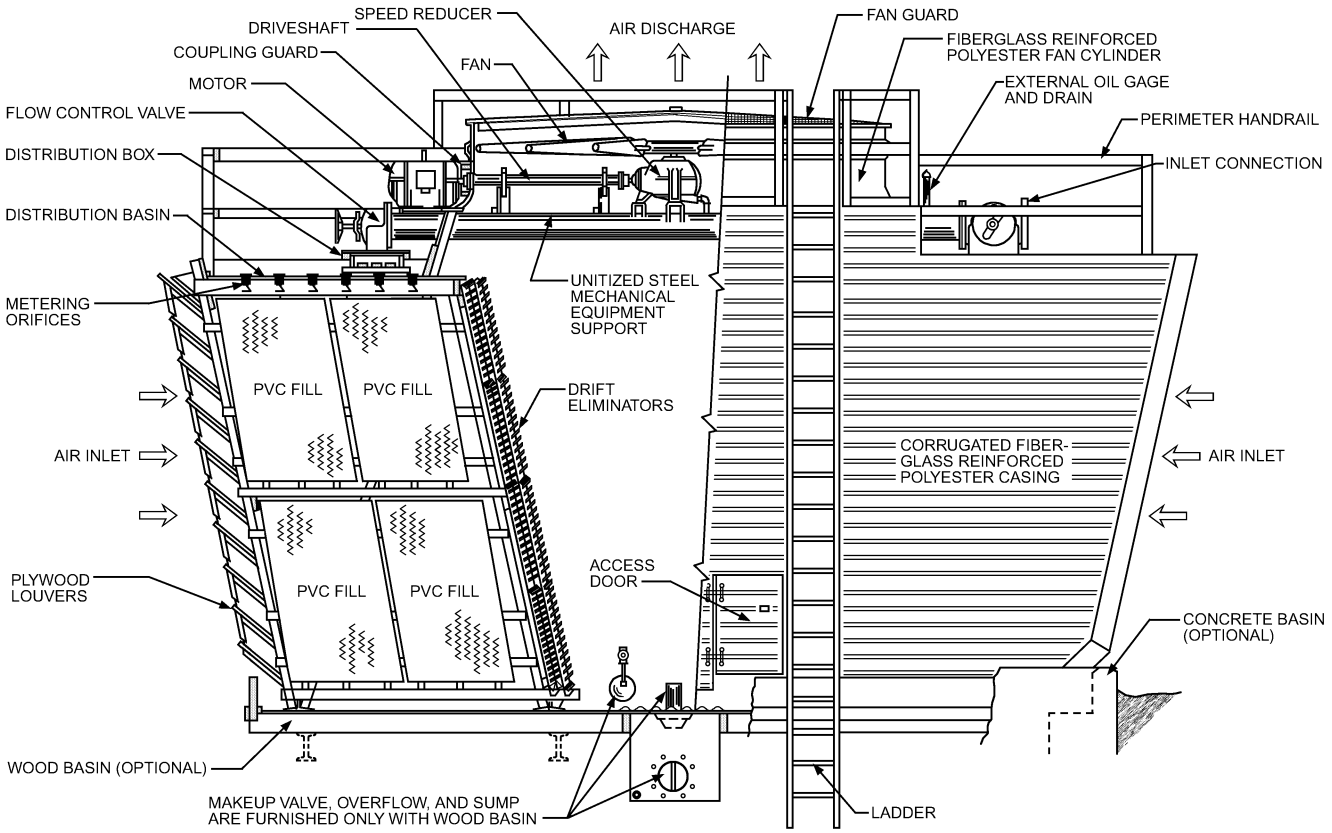

Fig. 13 Field-Erected Cross-Flow Mechanical-Draft Cooling Tower

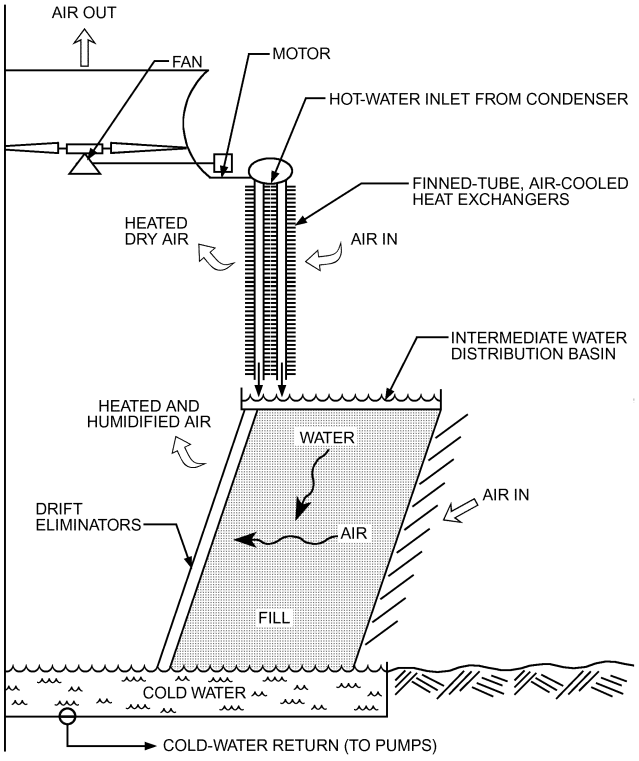

Fig. 14 Combination Wet/Dry Cooling Tower

pump systems and screw compressor oil pump systems, and wherever the reduced maintenance and greater reliability of a closed-loop system are desired. Closed-circuit cooling towers also provide cooling for multiple heat loads on a centralized closed-loop system.

Indirect-contact cooling towers (see Figure 4) require a closed-circuit heat exchanger (usually tubular serpentine coil bundles) that is exposed to air/water cascades similar to the fill of a cooling tower.

Some types include supplemental film or splash fill sections to augment the external heat exchange surface area. In Figure 6, air flows down over the coil, parallel to the recirculating water, and exits horizontally into the fan plenum. Recirculating water then flows over cooling tower fill, where it is further cooled by a second airstream before being reintroduced over the coil. Open- and closed-circuit cooling tower capacities are not directly comparable because of the intermediate step of heat transfer in the closed-circuit design. Closed-circuit cooling towers are more readily comparable to a combination of an open-circuit cooling tower and liquid-to-liquid heat exchanger, such as a plate-and-frame heat exchanger (see Figure 28).

Hybrid Closed-Circuit Cooling Towers

Hybrid closed-circuit cooling towers combine sensible and evaporative cooling to reduce water and energy requirements compared to conventional cooling equipment.In some designs, an adiabatic mode is also used.

Water savings are achieved through different operational combinations of these cooling types. When more adiabatic, direct evaporative, or indirect evaporative cooling is used, less energy is consumed at the expense of using more water. Conversely, when more direct sensible cooling is used, less water is consumed at the expense of using more energy. The following operational modes can be used singly or in combination.

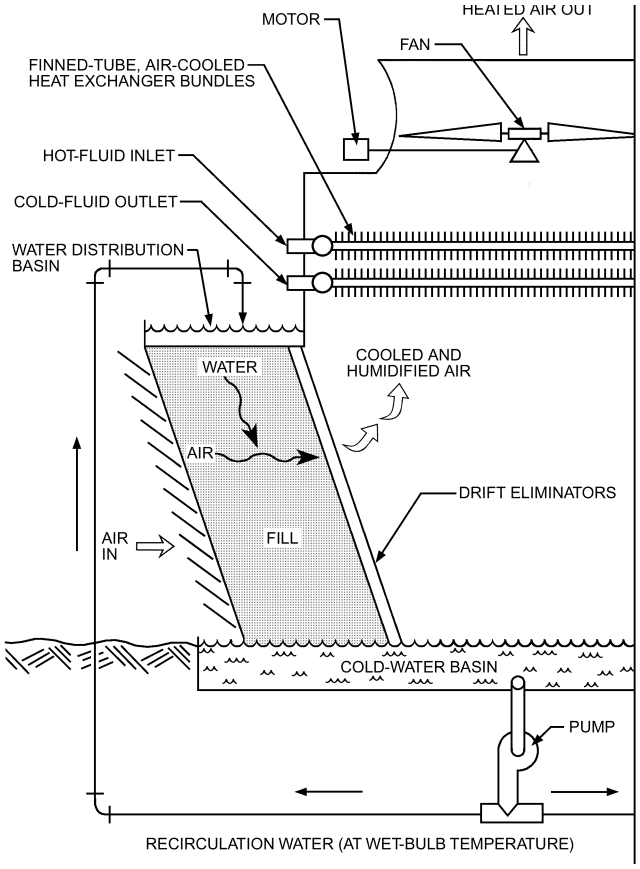

Fig. 15 Adiabatically Saturated Air-Cooled Heat Exchanger

Wet Mode (Figure 16). This mode uses only evaporative cooling during elevated temperature or load conditions. It optimizes fan energy and/or process fluid temperatures with increased water consumption from evaporation.

Dry/Wet Mode (Figure 17). The dry/wet mode simultaneously uses evaporative and sensible cooling when allowed by moderate temperature and/or load conditions. This mode meets load requirements while reducing water consumption from evaporation through increased fan energy consumption or modulating flow through the evaporative coil. In this mode, plume is reduced (and may be eliminated), depending on ambient conditions and load.

Adiabatic Mode (Figure 18). This mode rejects heat through the dry coil, and the recirculating spray water merely serves to saturate and adiabatically precool incoming outdoor air. Adiabatic cooling of the incoming air results in lower air temperatures, which increases the rate of sensible heat transfer. Visible plume and water consumption are greatly reduced compared to traditional wet or wet/dry mode.

Dry Mode (Figure 19). The dry mode uses sensible cooling when allowed by reduced load and/or ambient temperatures. This mode eliminates water consumption from evaporation while meeting load requirements through increased fan energy. Plume is avoided with this mode.

Modular Fluid Coolers with Mixed Operational Mode

Modular fluid coolers (Figure 20) consist of one or more modules. The modular construction enables mixed modes of operation to effectively balance water and energy savings. Some of the modules can be running in a wet, or evaporative mode, while others simultaneously run in a dry (sensible) mode. Automatic controls

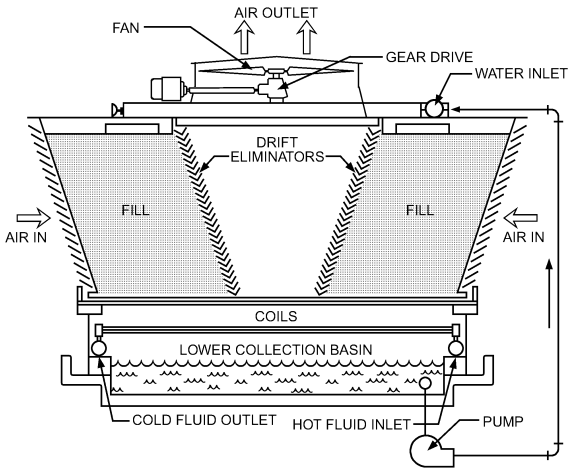

Fig. 16 Hybrid Cooling Towers in Wet Operational Mode

modulate the numbers of modules running in each mode and the relative fan speeds to achieve the right balance for the specific situation, according to specific climate, cooling load profile, and the relative costs for water and energy.

Adiabatic Fluid Coolers

This class of closed-circuit cooling towers can operate in either a dry (sensible) or adiabatic mode, wherein the entering air is drawn through wetted fibrous cellulous pads before entering a finned coil arrangement. In the adiabatic process, water is evaporated from the wetted pads, cooling the air (Figure 21). In the dry mode, the water is shut off and the unit operates similar to a dry cooler.

Figures 22 and 23 show, respectively, an example of an adiabatic pad precooling system and the various pad designs and thicknesses that are used. Alternatively, a series of pipes and fine spray nozzles (Figure 24) are placed on the air inlet side of a finned coil to saturate the air in lieu of pads. To minimize scaling of the finned coils in these designs, a water softener is often used on the water supply system.

Units operating in adiabatic mode deliver the specified leaving fluid temperature in a smaller footprint and/or at lower fan motor powerthan a completely dry unit. Compared to traditional evaporative systems, adiabatic fluid coolers can significantly reduce water consumption. They have controls that ensure water is only used when the ambient conditions and load require it; otherwise, the unit operates dry. In either mode, fan speed is controlled by a variable-speed device to match the load.

Reducing water consumption also reduces expenses (e.g., purchase, treatment, and disposal of water). There are various types of adiabatic pad precooling systems, including recirculating basin and pump systems with basin draining sequences, and once-through systems, in which the water not evaporated from the pad goes directly to drain.

Saturation Efficiency. The saturation efficiency of adiabatic pads denotes their effectiveness at lowering the passing air to wet-bulb temperature. It varies with pad design, pad thickness, and airspeed, and is provided by all pad manufacturers. For more information, see Cooling Technology Institute's technical paper 19-25 (CTI 2019).

The entering air temperature to the heat exchanger can then be calculated as

$$T_{DDB} = T_{DB} - \mathrm{SE}(T_{DB} - T_{WB}) = 35 - 0.75(35 - 25.6) = 27.95 \quad (2)$$

where

SE = saturation efficiency of pad,%

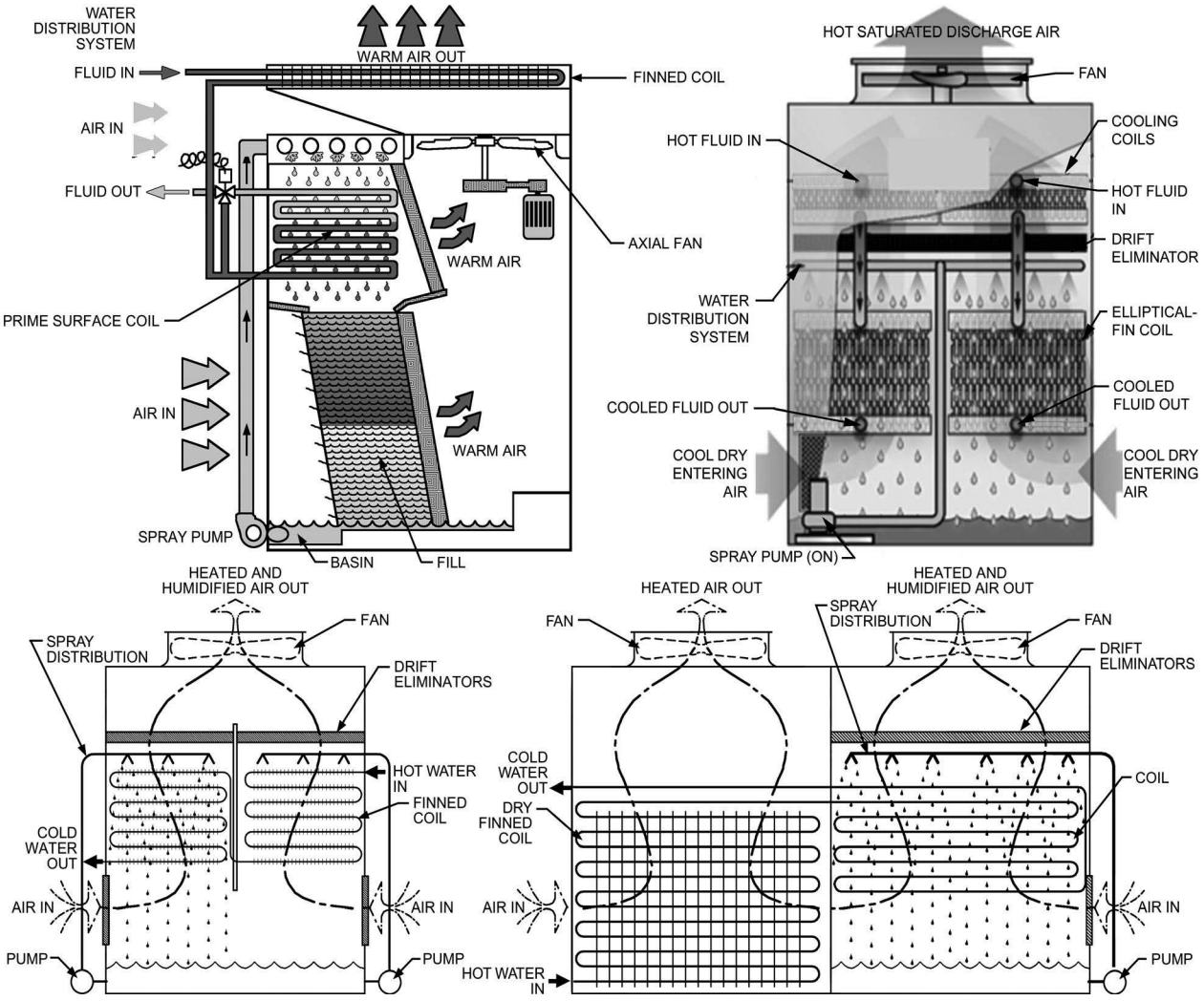

Fig. 17 Hybrid Cooling Towers in Dry/Wet Operational Mode

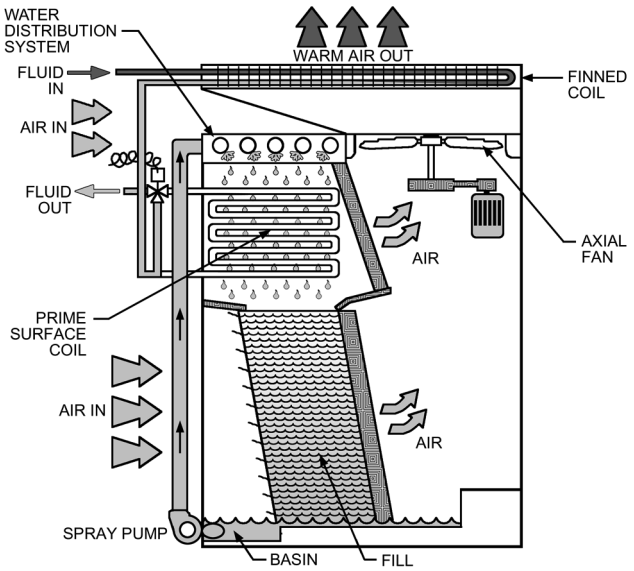

Fig. 18 Hybrid Cooling Tower in Adiabatic Operational Mode

T_{DB} = entering air dry-bulb temperature to pad, °C
T_{WB} = entering air wet-bulb temperature to pad, °C
T_{DDB} = depressed air dry-bulb temperature to finned heat exchanger, °C

To determine saturation efficiency via testing, measure all other temperatures and using the following equation (Figure 25):

$$SE = \frac{T_{DB} - T_{DDB}}{T_{DB} - T_{WB}} = \frac{35 - 27.95}{35 - 25.6} = 75\% \quad (3)$$

4. MATERIALS OF CONSTRUCTION

Materials for cooling tower construction are usually selected to meet the expected water quality and atmospheric conditions.

Wood. In the past, wood was used extensively for all static components except hardware, primarily on field-erected towers and occasionally on factory-assembled towers. Redwood and fir predominated, usually with postfabrication pressure treatment of waterborne preservative chemicals, typically chromated copper arsenate (CCA) or acid copper chromate (ACC). These microbicidal chemicals prevent the attack of wood-destructive organisms such as termites or fungi. Environmental restrictions on treatment chemicals, concerns about potential leaching of those chemicals into the environment, and variations in

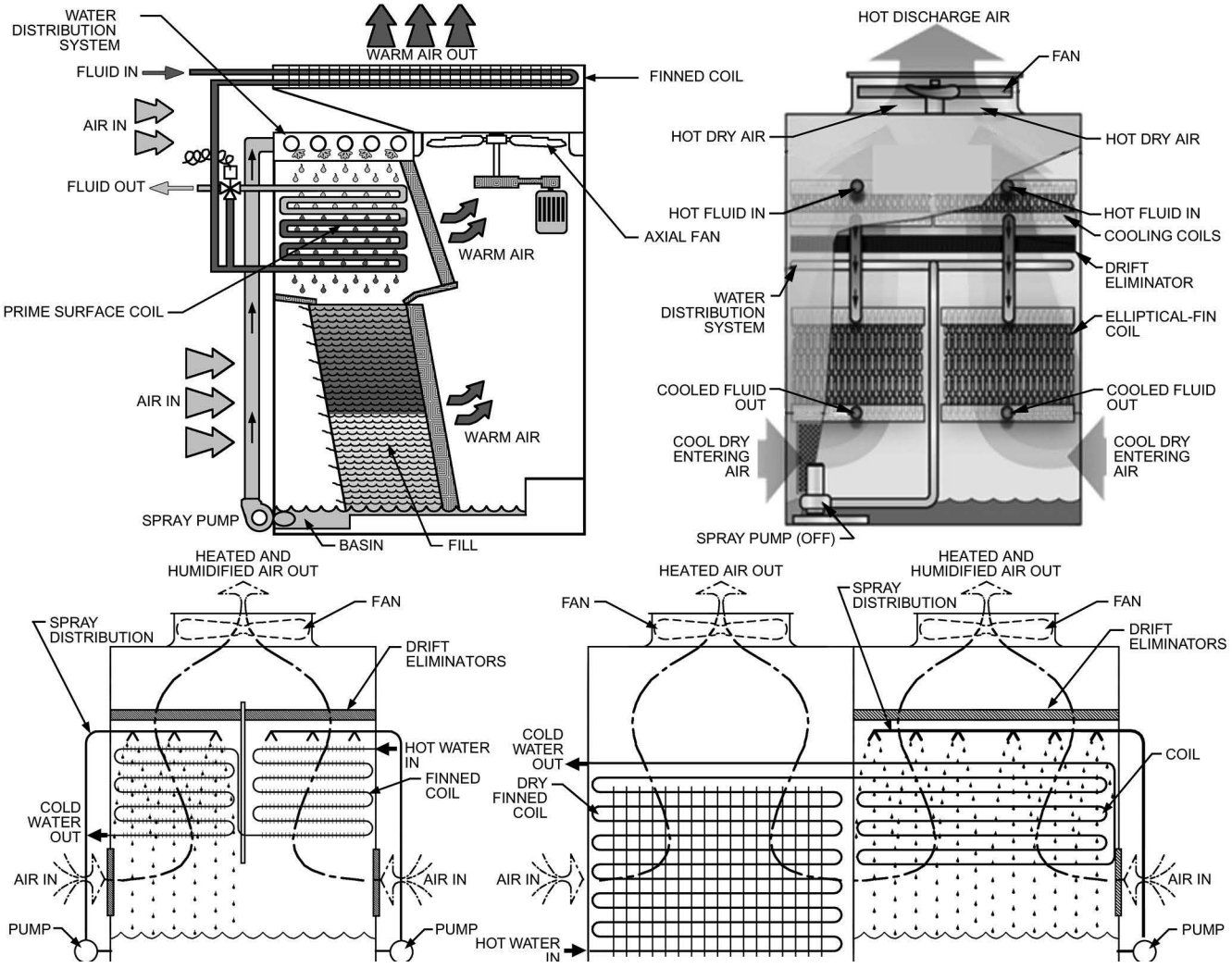

Fig. 19 Hybrid Cooling Towers in Dry Operational Mode

structural properties of individual wood members have reduced its popularity, and it has been largely replaced with fiber-reinforced plastics.

Metals. Steel with galvanized zinc is used for small and medium-sized installations. Hot-dip galvanizing after fabrication is used for larger weldments. Hot-dip galvanizing and cadmium and zinc plating are used for hardware. Brasses and bronzes are selected for special hardware, fittings, and tubing material. Stainless steels (mainly 301L, 304, and 316) are often used for sheet metal, drive shafts, and hardware in exceptionally corrosive atmospheres or to extend unit life. Stainless steel cold-water basins are increasingly popular. Cast iron is a common choice for base castings, fan hubs, motor or gear reduction housings, and piping valve components. Metals coated with polyurethane and PVC are used selectively for special components. Two-part epoxy compounds and hybrid epoxy powder coatings are also used for key components or entire cooling towers.

Plastics. Fiberglass-reinforced plastic (FRP) materials are used for components such as structure, piping, fan cylinders, fan blades, casing, louvers, and structural connecting components. Polypropylene and acrylonitrile butadiene styrene (ABS) are specified for injection-molded components, such as fill bars and flow orifices. PVC is typically used as fill, eliminator, and louver materials. Reinforced plastic mortar is used in larger piping systems, coupled by neoprene O-ring-gasketed bell and spigot joints.

Graphite Composites. Graphite composite drive shafts are available for use on cooling tower installations. These shafts offer a strong, corrosion-resistant alternative to steel/stainless steel shafts and are often less expensive, more forgiving of misalignment, and transmit less vibration.

Concrete, Masonry, and Tile. Concrete is typically specified for cold-water basins of field-erected cooling towers and is used in piping, casing, and structural systems of the largest towers, primarily in the power and process industries. Special tiles and masonry are used when aesthetic considerations are important.

5. SELECTION CONSIDERATIONS

Selecting the proper water-cooling equipment for a specific application requires consideration of cooling duty, economics, required services, environmental conditions, maintenance requirements, and aesthetics. Many of these factors are interrelated, but they should be evaluated individually.

Because a wide variety of water-cooling equipment may meet the required cooling duty, factors such as height, length, width, volume of airflow, fan and pump energy consumption, materials of construction, water quality, and availability influence final equipment selection.

The optimum choice is generally made after an economic evaluation. Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*

describes two common methods of economic evaluation: life-cycle costing and payback analysis. Each of these procedures compares equipment on the basis of total owning, operating, and maintenance costs.

Initial-cost comparisons consider the following factors:

- Erected cost of equipment
- Costs of interface with other subsystems, including
  - Basin grillage and value of the space occupied
  - Pumps and prime movers
  - Electrical wiring to pump and fan motors
  - Electrical controls and switchgear
  - Piping to and from the cooling tower (some designs require more inlet and discharge connections than others, thus affecting the cost of piping)
  - Cooling tower basin, basin screens, overflow piping, and makeup lines, if not furnished by the manufacturer
  - Shutoff and control valves, if not furnished by the manufacturer
  - Walkways, ladders, etc., providing access to the tower, if not furnished by the manufacturer
  - Fire protection sprinkler system

In evaluating owning and maintenance costs, consider the following major items:

- System energy costs (fans, pumps, etc.) on the basis of operating hours per year
- Energy demand charges
- Expected equipment life
- Maintenance and repair costs
- Money costs
- Life-cycle cost
- Water availability

Other factors are (1) safety features and safety codes; (2) conformity to building codes; (3) general design and rigidity of structures; (4) relative effects of corrosion, scale, or deterioration on service life; (5) availability of spare parts; (6) experience and reliability of manufacturers; (7) independent certification of thermal ratings; and (8) operating flexibility for economical operation at varying loads or during seasonal changes. In addition, equipment vibration, sound levels, acoustical attenuation, and compatibility with the architectural design are important. The following section details many of these more important considerations.

6. APPLICATION

This section describes some of the major design considerations, but the cooling tower manufacturer should be consulted for more detailed recommendations.

Siting

When a cooling tower can be located in an open space with free air motion and unimpeded air supply, siting is normally not an obstacle to satisfactory installation. However, cooling towers are often situated indoors, against walls, or in enclosures. In such cases, the following factors must be considered:

- Sufficient free and unobstructed space should be provided around the unit to ensure an adequate air supply to the fans and to allow proper servicing.
- Cooling tower discharge air should not be deflected in any way that might promote recirculation (a portion of the warm, moist discharge air reentering the cooling tower [Figure 26]). Recirculation raises the entering wet-bulb temperature, increasing hot- and cold-water temperatures, and, during cold-weather operation, can promote icing of air intake areas. The possibility of air recirculation should be considered, particularly on multiple-tower installations.

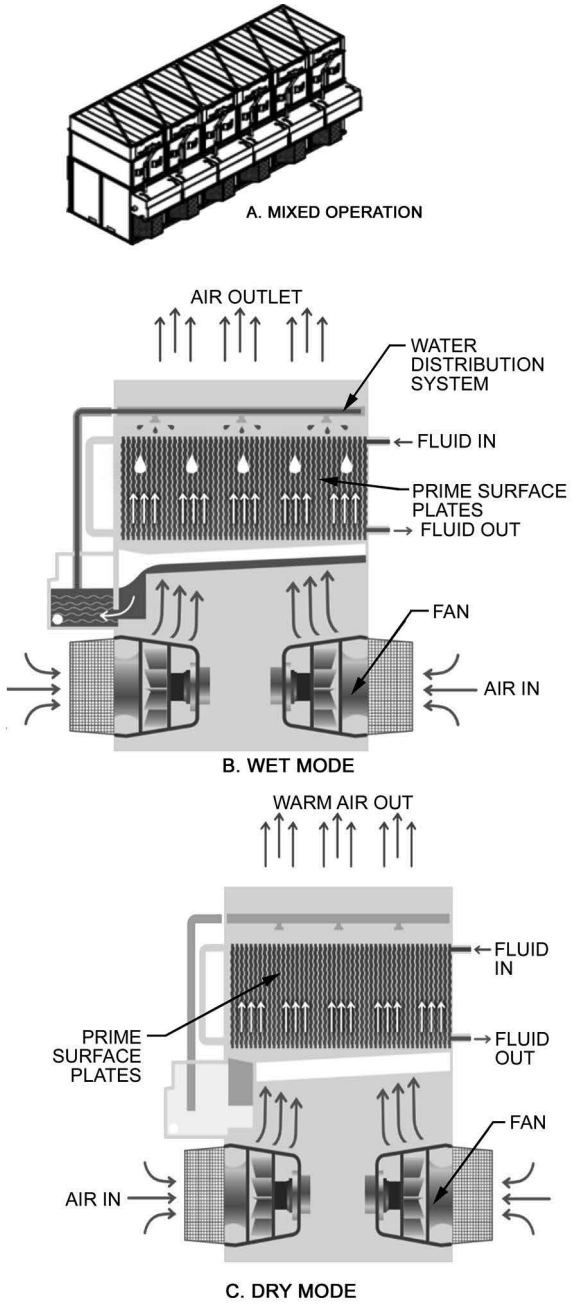

Fig. 20 Modular Fluid Coolers Capable of (A) Mixed Operational Mode, (B) Wet Mode, and (C) Dry Mode

Also, cooling towers should be located to prevent introducing the warm discharge air and any associated drift, which may contain chemical and/or biological contaminants, into the fresh air intake of the building the tower serves or into those of adjacent buildings.

Location of the cooling tower is usually determined by one or more of the following: (1) structural support requirements, (2) rigging limitations, (3) local codes and ordinances, (4) cost of bringing auxiliary services to the cooling tower, and (5) architectural compatibility. Sound, plume, and drift considerations are also best handled by proper site selection during the planning stage. For additional information on seismic and wind restraint, see Chapter 56 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

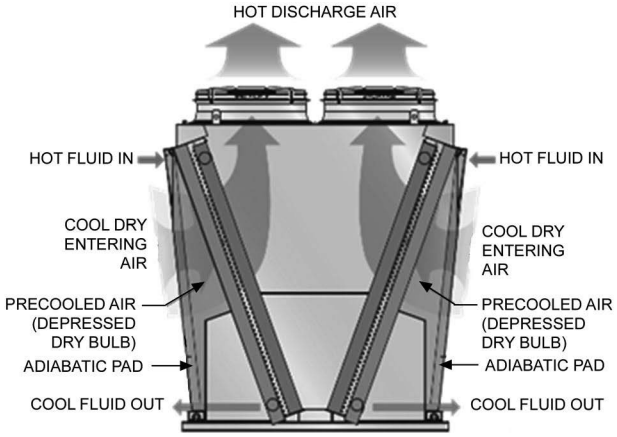

Fig. 21 Adiabatic Fluid Cooler in Adiabatic Operational Mode

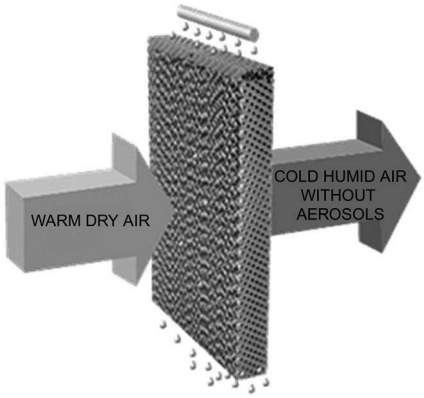

Fig. 22 Example of Adiabatic Pad Precooling System

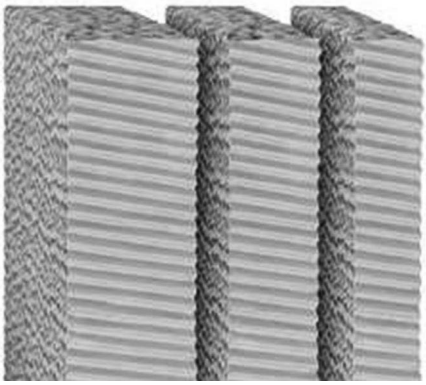

Fig. 23 Example of Corrugated Adiabatic Pads

Fig. 24 Example of Adiabatic Spray Precooling System

Piping

Piping should be adequately sized according to standard commercial practice. All piping should be designed to allow expansion and contraction. If the cooling tower has more than one inlet connection, balancing valves should be installed to balance the flow to each cell properly. Positive shutoff valves should be used, if necessary, to isolate individual cells for servicing.

When two or more cooling towers operate in parallel, an equalizer line between the cooling tower basins handles imbalances in the piping to and from the units and changing flow rates that arise from obstructions such as clogged orifices and strainers. All heat exchangers, and as much tower piping as possible, should be installed below the operating water level in the cooling tower to prevent the cooling tower overflowing at shutdown and to ensure satisfactory pump operation during start-up. Cooling tower basins must carry the proper amount of water during operation to prevent air entrainment into the water suction line. Basins should also have enough reserve volume between the operating and overflow levels to fill riser and water distribution lines on start-up and to fulfill the water-in-suspension requirement of the cooling tower. Unlike open cooling towers, closed-circuit cooling towers can be installed anywhere, even below the heat exchangers, because the fluid to be cooled is contained in a closed loop; the external spray water is self contained within the closed-circuit cooling tower.

Capacity Control

Most cooling towers encounter substantial changes in ambient wet-bulb temperature and load during the normal operating season. Accordingly, some form of capacity control may be required to maintain prescribed system temperatures or process conditions.

Frequency-modulating controls for fan motor speed can provide virtually infinite capacity control and energy management. Previously, automatic, variable-pitch propeller fans were the only way to do this. However, these mechanically complex drive systems are more expensive and have higher sound levels, because they operate at full design speed only. They have been replaced by variable-frequency drives (VFDs) coupled with a standard fixed-pitch fan, thereby saving more fan energy and operating significantly more quietly than cycling fans, especially at less than full load.

Variable-frequency fan drives are economical and can save considerable energy as well as extend the life of the motor, fan, and drive (gearbox or V-belt) assembly compared to fan cycling or two-speed control. However, the following special considerations must be discussed with the cooling tower manufacturer and the supplier of the VFD:

- Care must be taken to avoid operating the fan system at a critical speed or a multiple thereof. **Critical speeds** are fan operating speeds identical to one of the natural frequencies of the fan assembly and/or supporting structure. At these speeds, fan resonance occurs, resulting in excessive vibration and possibly fan system failure, sometimes very quickly. Consult the tower manufacturer on what speeds (if any) must be avoided. Alternatively, the tower can be tested at start-up using an accelerometer to identify critical

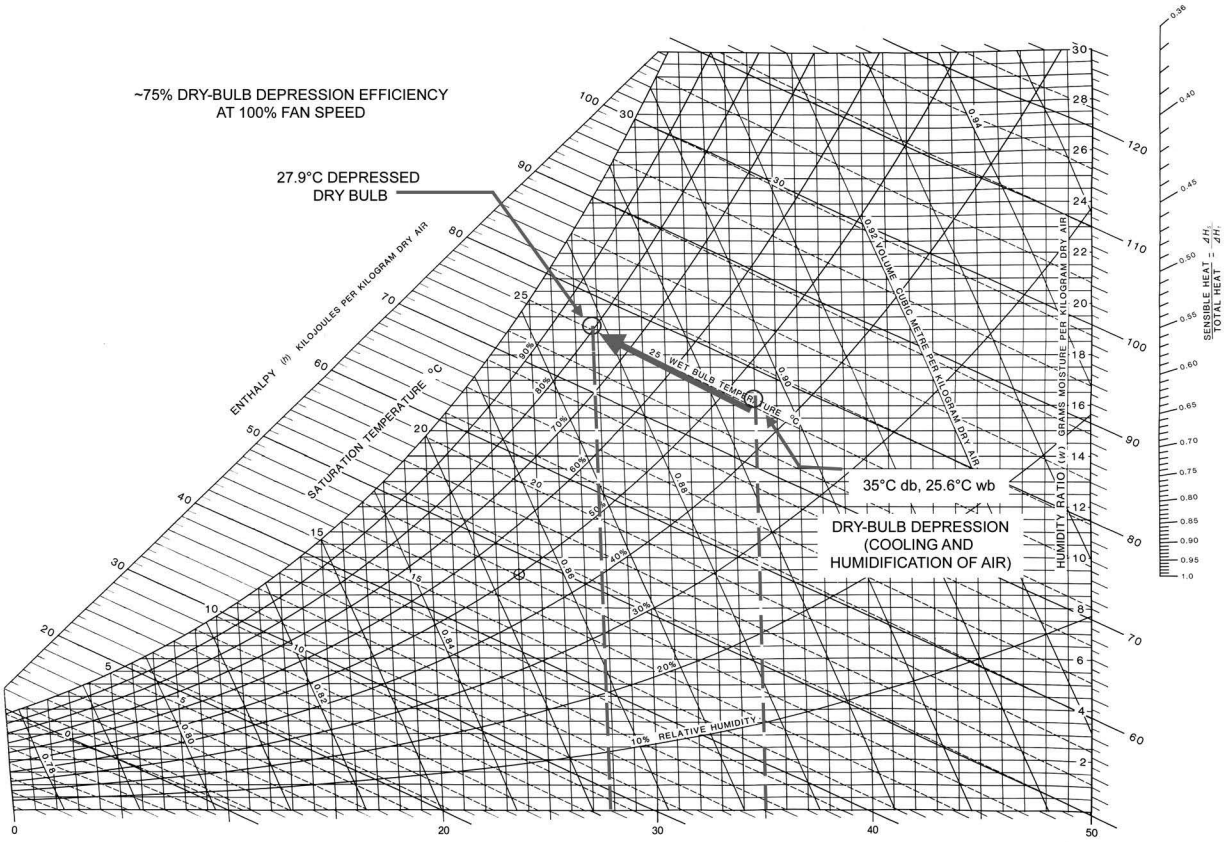

Fig. 25 Psychrometric Chart Showing Depressed Dry Bulb: Entering Air at 35°C db, 25.6°C wb, and 75% Pad Saturation Efficiency

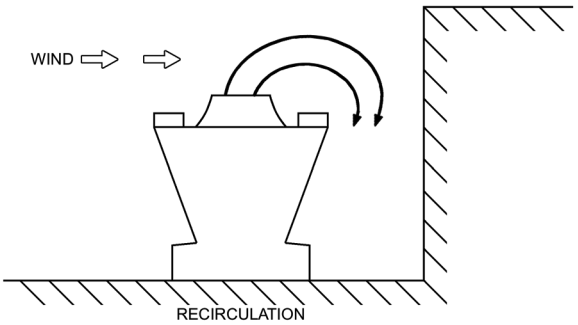

Fig. 26 Discharge Air Reentering Cooling Tower

frequencies throughout the full speed range, though this is generally not necessary with pre-engineered, factory-assembled units. Critical frequencies, identified either by the manufacturer or through actual testing, must be locked out in the VFD skip frequency program.

- Some VFDs, particularly pulse-width modulating (PWM) drives, create overvoltages at the motor that can cause motor and bearing failures. The magnitude of these overvoltages increases significantly with the length of cable between the controller and the motor, so lead lengths should be kept as short as possible. Special motors, filters, or other corrective measures may be necessary to ensure dependable operation. Consult the cooling tower manufacturer and/or the VFD supplier. Chapter 45 also has more information on variable-frequency drives.
- A VFD-compatible motor should be specified on all cooling towers with variable-frequency drive.
- Most VFDs can modulate down to 10% or less of full motor speed. However, a given cooling tower may have special limits below 25% speed. If operating below 25% speed, consult the cooling tower manufacturer on the possible limits of their equipment.

Fan cycling is another method of capacity control on cooling towers and has often been used on multiple-unit or multiple-cell installations. In nonfreezing climates, where close control of exit water temperature is not essential, fan cycling is an adequate and inexpensive method of capacity control. However, motor burnout from too-frequent cycling is a concern.

Two-speed fan motors or additional lower-power pony motors, in conjunction with fan cycling, can double the number of steps of capacity control compared to fan cycling alone. This is particularly useful on single-fan motor units, which would have only one step of capacity control by fan cycling. Two-speed fan motors provide the added advantage of reduced energy consumption at reduced load. Pony motors, which are typically sized for 1/3 of the power of the main motor, provide redundancy in case one motor fails in addition to energy savings.

It is more economical to operate all fans at the same speed than to operate one fan at full speed before starting the next. For example, two cells operating at half speed (12.5% of full-speed power) have similar cooling capacity as one cell operating at full speed and one cell with the fan off. However, two cells operating at half speed use one-fourth the power (12.5% + 12.5%) of the one cell operating at full speed (100%). Figure 27 compares cooling tower fan power versus speed for single-, two-, and variable-speed fan motors.

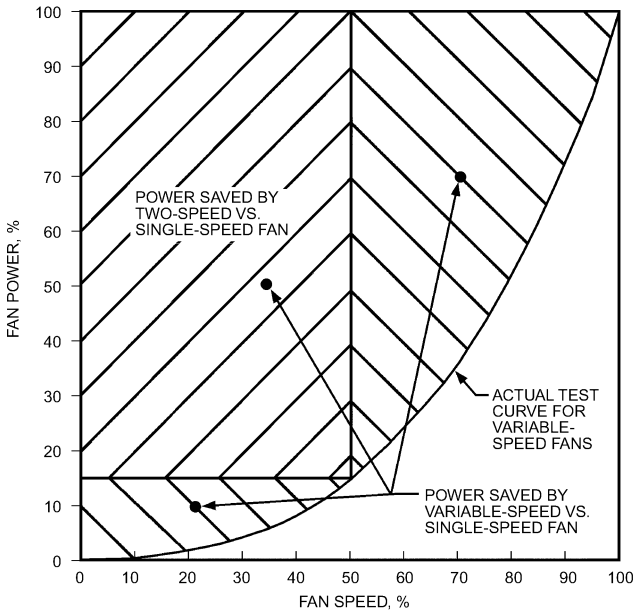

Fig. 27 Cooling Tower Fan Power Versus Speed

(White 1994)

Modulating dampers in the discharge of centrifugal blower fans are also used for cooling tower capacity control, as well as for energy management. In some cases, modulating dampers may be used with two-speed motors. Note that modulating dampers have been replaced by variable-frequency drives for these purposes.

Cooling towers that inject water to induce airflow through the cooling tower have various pumping arrangements for capacity control. Multiple pumps in series or two-speed pumping provide capacity control and also reduce energy consumption.

Modulating water bypasses for capacity control should be used only after consultation with the cooling tower manufacturer. This is particularly important at low ambient conditions in which reduced water flow can promote freezing within the cooling tower.

Energy can be saved in multicell tower installations by operating multiple cells together at part-load conditions instead of turning individual cells off.

To take advantage of the energy savings of operating two cells at half speed instead of one at full speed, it is important to control all fans together and maintain water flow over all cells. For cooling towers with two-speed motors, all cells should be brought up to the lower speed first (usually half speed) before switching any cells to full speed. For VFD operation, all cells should be started and ramped up and down together. Operating the fans in this way maximizes tower energy savings. In some cases, this can cut the annual cooling tower energy usage by half or more.

In addition to fan motor control, flow control can also offer substantial savings. Process, simplicity, and/or cost of piping drives many installations to pipe one tower cell or pairs of cells for each process instead of connecting all processes together with a common manifold. An example of this is one chiller per cooling tower cell for installations with multiple chillers. The thought is that when one chiller is turned off, the operator can also turn off the associated cooling tower and pump. Although this can save energy, more energy can be saved by keeping the cooling tower cell on and spreading the condenser return water from the remaining chillers over all tower cells. For the previous two-cell example, the operation consists of two cooling towers on, one chiller on, one pump on. In essence, each cooling tower cell operates at half of design flow. Half flow equals half heat load per cell, which in turn equals half fan speed and 1/8 the power draw per cell, or 1/4 (1/8 + 1/8) the full-speed power of one cell. Combining this with fan motor control yields the most efficient method of tower capacity control. To use this flow control strategy, the following must be considered:

- Not all cooling towers in all situations can operate at 50% flow or less. The cooling tower manufacturer can best clarify the reduced-flow operational limits of their product and how best to operate.
- Manufacturers may require special options or control recommendations for operation at reduced flow in freezing environments. For more information, see the section on Winter Operation.
- Operating the cooling tower at some reduced flows may create dry spots in film fill heat transfer media. Under the right conditions and water quality, this can cause scale build-up, which reduces the tower's effective capacity. Consult the manufacturer on the product's capabilities and any special requirements or options.

Water-Side Economizer (Free Cooling)

With an appropriately equipped and piped system, using the cooling tower for free cooling during reduced load and/or reduced ambient conditions can significantly reduce system energy consumption. Because the cooling tower's cold-water temperature drops as the load and ambient temperature drop, the water temperature will eventually be low enough to serve the load directly, allowing the energy-intensive chiller to be shut off. Figures 28 to 30 outline three methods of free cooling but do not show all of the piping, valving, and controls that may be necessary for the functioning of a specific system. Compared to air-side economizers, water-side economizers can significantly reduce the risk of both particulate and gaseous contamination as well as humidity issues by reducing the amount of outdoor air required beyond that needed for ventilation. Additionally, using a closed-circuit cooling tower or an open cooling tower with a liquid-to-liquid heat exchanger and the associated piping and controls is often less expensive than the addition of large outdoor air louvers and dampers and the associated control system required with air-side economizer systems for larger facilities, especially data centers. Additionally, the water-side economizer system may offer the benefit of improved reliability.

Maximum use of free cooling occurs when a drop in the ambient temperature reduces the need for dehumidification. Therefore, higher temperatures in the chilled-water circuit can normally be tolerated during the free-cooling season and are beneficial to the system's heating/cooling balance. In many cases, typical 7°C chilled-water temperatures are allowed to rise to 13°C or higher in free cooling. This maximizes cooling tower usage and minimizes system energy consumption. Some applications require a constant chilled-water supply temperature, which can reduce the hours of free cooling operation, depending on ambient temperatures.

If the spray water temperature is allowed to fall too low, freezing may be a concern. Close control of spray water temperature per the manufacturer's recommendations minimizes unit icing and helps ensure trouble-free operation. Refer to the guidelines from the manufacturer and to the section on Winter Operation in this chapter.

Indirect Free Cooling. This type of cooling separates the condenser-water and chilled-water circuits and may be accomplished in the following ways:

- A separate heat exchanger in the system (usually plate-and-frame) allows heat to transfer from the chilled-water circuit to the condenser-water circuit by total bypass of the chiller system (Figure 28).
- An indirect-contact, closed-circuit evaporative cooling tower (Figures 4, 6, and 7) also allows indirect free cooling and eliminates the

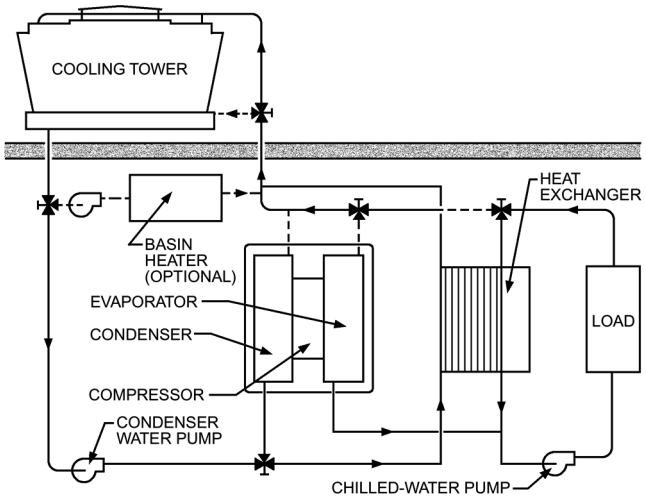

Fig. 28 Free Cooling by Auxiliary Heat Exchanger

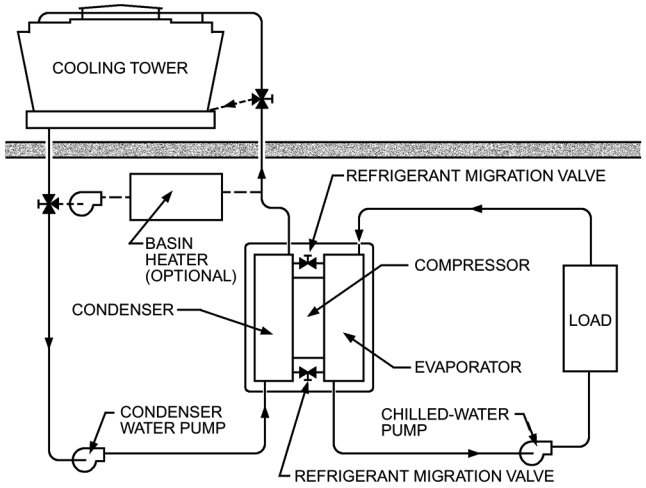

Fig. 29 Free Cooling by Refrigerant Vapor Migration

need for an additional heat exchanger. Its use is covered in the following section on Direct Free Cooling.

- In vapor migration system (Figure 29), bypasses between the evaporator and condenser allow migratory flow of refrigerant vapor to the condenser; they also allow gravity flow of liquid refrigerant back to the evaporator without compressor operation. Not all chiller systems are adaptable to this arrangement, and those that are may offer limited load capability under this mode. In some cases, auxiliary pumps enhance refrigerant flow and, therefore, load capability.

Direct Free Cooling. This type of cooling involves interconnecting the condenser-water and chilled-water circuits so the cooling tower water serves the load directly (Figure 30). In this case, the chilled-water pump is normally bypassed so design water flow can be maintained to the cooling tower. The primary disadvantage of the direct free-cooling system is that it allows the relatively dirty condenser water to contaminate the clean chilled-water system. Although filtration systems (either side-stream or full-flow) minimize this contamination, many specifiers consider it to be an overriding concern. Using a closed-circuit (indirect-contact) cooling tower eliminates this contamination. During summer, water

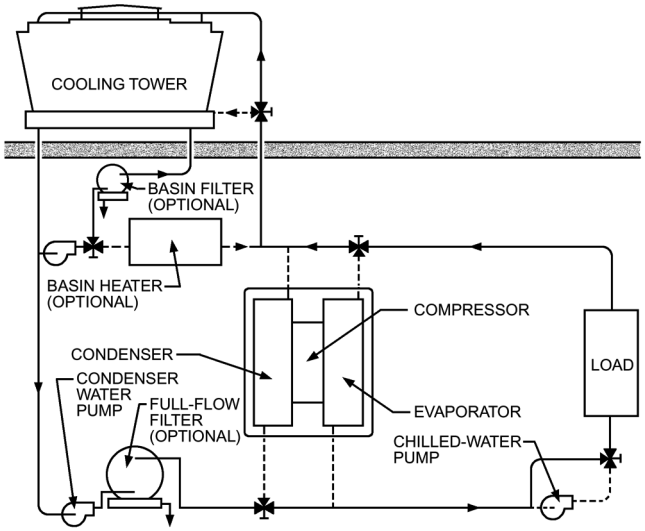

Fig. 30 Free Cooling by Interconnection of Water Circuits

from the cooling tower is circulated in a closed loop through the condenser. During winter, water from the cooling tower is circulated in a closed loop directly through the chilled-water circuit.

Winter Operation

When a cooling tower is to be used in freezing climates, the following design and operating considerations are necessary.

Open Circulating Water. Direct-contact cooling towers can be winterized by a suitable method of capacity control that maintains the temperature of water leaving the cooling tower well above freezing. In addition, during cold weather, regular visual inspections of the cooling tower should be made to ensure all controls are operating properly.

On induced-draft axial fan cooling towers, fans may be periodically operated in reverse, usually at low speed, to deice the air intake areas. Using fan cycling or (preferably) variable-frequency drives minimizes the possibility of icing by matching cooling tower capability with the load. Some icing can be expected at the cold air/water interface. Good operating practice includes frequent inspections of the cooling tower, especially during extremely cold weather.

Recirculation of moist discharge air on forced-draft equipment can cause ice formation on inlet air screens and fans. Installing vibration cutout switches can minimize the risk of damage from ice formation on rotating equipment.

Closed Circulating Water. Precautions beyond those mentioned for open circulating water must be taken to protect the fluid inside the heat exchanger of a closed-circuit fluid cooling tower. When system design allows, the best protection is to use an antifreeze solution. When this is not possible, supplemental heat must be provided to the heat exchanger, and the manufacturer should be consulted about the amount of heat input required. Positive-closure damper hoods are also available from many manufacturers to reduce heat loss from the coil section and thus reduce the amount of heat input required.

All exposed piping to and from the closed-circuit cooling tower should be insulated and heat traced. In case of a power failure during freezing weather and where water is used in the system, the heat exchanger should include an emergency draining system.

Basin Water. Freeze protection for basin water in an idle cooling tower or closed-circuit cooling tower can be obtained by various means. A good method is to use an auxiliary sump tank located in a heated space. When a remote sump is impractical, auxiliary heat

must be supplied to the cooling tower basin to prevent freezing. Common sources are electric immersion heaters and steam and hot-water coils. Towers that do not operate in the winter should be cleaned and drained. Consult the cooling tower manufacturer for the exact heat requirements to prevent freezing at design winter temperatures. Using dry cooling on closed-circuit cooling towers during winter operation eliminates the potential for ice build-up on air inlet louvers and may allow the basin water to be drained.

All exposed water lines susceptible to freezing should be protected by electric heat tape or cable and insulation. This precaution applies to all lines or portions of lines that have water in them when the cooling tower is shut down.

Sound

Sound has become an important consideration in the selection and siting of outdoor equipment such as cooling towers and other evaporative cooling devices. Many communities have enacted legislation that limits allowable sound levels of outdoor equipment. Even if legislation does not exist, people who live and work near a cooling tower installation may object if the sound intrudes on their environment. Because the cost of correcting a sound problem may exceed the original cost of the cooling tower, sound should be considered in the early stages of system design.

To determine the acceptability of cooling tower sound levels in a given environment, the first step is to establish a noise criterion for the area of concern. This may be an existing or pending code or an estimate of sound levels that will be acceptable to those living or working in the area. The second step is to estimate the sound levels generated by the tower at the critical area, taking into account the effects of the cooling tower installation geometry and the distance from the tower to the critical area. Often, the cooling tower manufacturer can supply sound rating data on a specific unit that serve as the basis for this estimate. Lastly, the noise criterion is compared to the estimated tower sound levels to determine the acceptability of the installation.

If the installation may present a sound problem, several potential solutions are available. It is good practice to situate the cooling tower as far as possible from any sound-sensitive areas. Many cooling towers are available with optional low-sound fans using wider-chord blades selected at lower tip speeds. Variable-frequency drives offer the additional advantage of reducing or eliminating the sound level fluctuations that occur with cycling of single- or two-speed motors; fluctuations are usually considered more objectionable than a constant or a slowly varying sound level. VFDs can also be programmed to run at lower speeds during light-load periods, such as at night, if these correspond to critical sound-sensitive periods.

In critical situations, effective solutions may include barrier walls between the cooling tower and the sound-sensitive area, acoustical treatment of the cooling tower, or using low-sound fans. Attenuators specifically designed for the tower are available from most manufacturers. It may also be practical to install a cooling tower larger than would normally be required and lower sound levels by operating the unit at reduced fan speed. This also has the advantage of saving energy because of the smaller fan motor(s), which can quickly pay for the added investment in the larger cooling tower. For additional information on sound control, see Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Drift

Water droplets become entrained in the airstream as it passes through the cooling tower. Although eliminators strip most of this water from the discharge airstream, some discharges from the tower as drift. The rate of drift loss from a cooling tower is a function of cooling tower configuration, eliminator design, airflow rate through the tower, and water loading. Generally, an efficient eliminator design reduces maximum drift loss to between 0.001 and 0.005% of the water circulation rate.

Because drift contains the minerals of the makeup water (which may be concentrated three to five times) and often contains water treatment chemicals, cooling towers should not be placed near parking areas, large windowed areas, or architectural surfaces sensitive to staining or scale deposits.

Fogging (Cooling Tower Plume)

Warm air discharged from a cooling tower is essentially saturated. Under certain operating conditions, the ambient air surrounding the tower cannot absorb all of the moisture in the tower discharge airstream, and the excess condenses as fog.

Fogging may be predicted by projecting a straight line on a psychrometric chart from the cooling tower entering air conditions to a point representing the discharge conditions (Figure 31). A line crossing the saturation curve indicates fog generation; the greater the area of intersection to the left of the saturation curve, the more intense the plume. Fog persistence depends on its original intensity and on the degree of mechanical and convective mixing with ambient air that dissipates the fog.

Methods of reducing or preventing fogging have taken many forms, including heating the cooling tower exhaust with natural gas burners or hot-water or steam coils, installing precipitators, and spraying chemicals at the tower exhaust. However, such solutions are generally costly to operate and are not always effective. The simplest solution is to allow the leaving water temperature to drop below design, which helps reduce the temperature difference between the water and the ambient air. This can reduce the density of the plume, making it less objectionable or, depending on the specific conditions, eliminating it. Hybrid closed-circuit cooling towers operating in dry/wet or dry mode can minimize or prevent fogging.

On larger, field-erected installations, combination wet/dry cooling towers, which combine the normal evaporative portion of a tower with a finned-tube dry surface heat exchanger section (in series or in parallel), afford a more practical means of plume control. In such units, the saturated discharge air leaving the evaporative section is mixed within the cooling tower with the warm, relatively dry air off the finned-coil section to produce a subsaturated air mixture leaving the cooling tower. In some closed-circuit

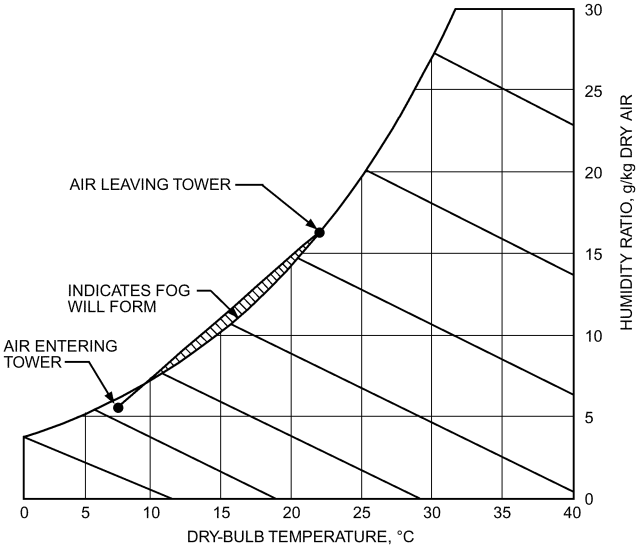

Fig. 31 Fog Prediction Using Psychrometric Chart

hybrid cooling tower designs, the dry and wet heat exchange sections combine to abate plume. This is accomplished by (1) reducing the amount of water evaporated by the wet coil by handling some of the heat load sensibly with the dry heat exchanger, and (2) simultaneously heating the discharge air with the incoming process fluid in the dry heat exchanger. In colder weather, these units can operate completely dry, eliminating plume altogether.

Often, however, the most practical solution to tower fogging is to locate the cooling tower where visible plumes, should they form, will not be objectionable. Accordingly, when selecting cooling tower sites, the potential for fogging and its effect on tower surroundings, such as large windowed areas or traffic arteries, should be considered.

Maintenance

Usually, the cooling tower manufacturer furnishes operating and maintenance manuals that include recommendations for procedures and intervals as well as parts lists for the specific unit. These recommendations should be followed when formulating the maintenance program for the cooling tower.

Efficient operation and thermal performance of a cooling tower depend not only on mechanical maintenance, but also on cleanliness. Accordingly, cooling tower owners should incorporate the following as a basic part of their maintenance program:

- Periodic inspection of mechanical equipment, fill, and both hot- and cold-water basins to ensure that they are maintained in a good state of repair.
- Periodic draining and cleaning of wetted surfaces and areas of alternate wetting and drying to prevent accumulation of dirt, scale, or biological organisms, such as algae and slime, in which bacteria may develop.
- Proper treatment of circulating water for biological control and corrosion, in accordance with accepted industry practice.
- Systematic documentation of operating and maintenance functions. This is extremely important because without it, no policing can be done to determine whether an individual has actually adhered to a maintenance policy.

Inspections

The following should be checked daily (no less than weekly) in an informal walk-through inspection. Areas requiring attention have been loosely grouped for clarity, although category distinctions are often hazy because the areas are interdependent.

Performance. Optimum performance and safety depend on the operation of each individual component at its designed capability. A single blocked strainer, for instance, can adversely affect the capacity and efficiency of the entire system. Operators should always be alert to any degradation in performance, because this usually is the first sign of a problem and is invaluable in pinpointing minor problems before they become major. Consult the equipment manufacturers to obtain specific information on each piece of equipment (for both maintenance and technical characteristics), and keep manuals handy for quick reference.

Check and record all water and refrigerant temperatures, pump pressures, outdoor conditions, and pressure drops (differential pressure) across condensers, heat exchangers and filtration devices. This record helps operators become familiar with the equipment as it operates under various load conditions and provides a permanent record that can be used to calculate flow rates, assess equipment efficiency, expedite diagnostic procedures, and adjust maintenance and water treatment regimens to obtain maximum performance from the system.

For units with water-side economizers using plate heat exchangers, check temperature and pressure differentials daily for evidence of clogging or fouling.

Major Mechanical Components. During cooling tower inspections, be alert for any unusual noise or vibration from pumps, motors, fans, and other mechanical equipment. This is often the first sign of mechanical trouble. Operators thoroughly familiar with their equipment generally have little trouble recognizing unusual conditions. Also listen for cavitation noises from pumps, which can indicate blocked strainers.

Check the cooling tower fan and drive system assembly for loose mounting hardware, condition of fasteners, grease and oil leaks, and noticeable vibration or wobble when the fan is running. Excessive vibration can rapidly deteriorate the tower.

Observe at least one fan start and stop each week. If a fan has a serious problem, lock it out of operation and call for expert assistance. To be safe, do not take chances by running defective fans.

Fan and drive systems should be professionally checked for dynamic balance, alignment, proper fan pitch (if adjustable), and vibration whenever major repair work is performed on the fan or if unusual noises or vibrations are present. It is good practice to have these items checked at least once every third year on all but the smallest cooling towers. Any vibration switches should be checked for proper operation at least annually.

Verify calibration of the fan thermostat periodically to prevent excessive cycling and to ensure that the most economical temperature to the chiller is maintained.

Cooling Tower Structure. Check the tower structure and casing for water and air leaks as well as deterioration. Inspect louvers, fill, and drift eliminators for clogging, excessive scale, or algal growth. Clean as necessary, using high-pressure water and taking care not to damage fragile fill and eliminator components.

Watch for excessive drift (water carryover), and take corrective action as required. Drift is the primary means of *Legionella* transmittal by cooling towers and evaporative condensers (see ASHRAE *Standard* 188 and *Guideline* 12 for recommendations on control of *Legionella*). Deteriorated drift eliminators should be replaced. Many older cooling towers have drift eliminators that contain asbestos. In the United States, deteriorated asbestos-type eliminators should as a rule be designated friable material and be handled and disposed of in a manner approved by the Environment Protection Agency (EPA) and the Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA).

Check the cooling tower basin, structural members and supports, fasteners, safety rails, and ladders for corrosion or other deterioration and repair as necessary. Replace deteriorated cooling tower components as required.

Water Distribution and Quality. Check the hot-water distribution system frequently, and clear clogged nozzles as required. Water distribution should be evenly balanced when the system is at rated flow and should be rechecked periodically. Cooling towers with open distribution pans benefit from covers, which retard algal growth. Pressurized water distribution systems "shaded" by eliminators also slow growth of algae.

The basin water level should be within the manufacturer's range for normal operating level, and high enough to allow most solids to settle out, thereby improving water quality to the equipment served by the cooling tower.

Cooling tower water should be clear, and the surface should not have an oily film, excessive foaming, or scum. Oil inhibits heat transfer in cooling towers, condensers, and other heat exchangers and should not be present in cooling tower water. Foam and scum can indicate excess organic material that can provide nutrients to bacteria (Rosa 1992). If such conditions are encountered, contact the water treatment specialist, who will take steps to correct the problem.

Check the cold-water basin in several places for corrosion, accumulated deposits, and excessive algae, because sediments and corrosion may not be uniformly distributed. Corrosion and microbiological

activity often occur under sediments. Cooling tower outlet strainers should be in place and free of clogging.

Do not neglect the strainers in the system. In-line strainers may be the single most neglected component in the average installation. They should be inspected and, if necessary, cleaned each time the cooling tower is cleaned. Pay particular attention to the small, fine strainers used on auxiliary equipment such as computer cooling units and blowdown lines.

Blow down chilled-water risers frequently, particularly on systems using direct free cooling. Exercise all valves in the system periodically by opening and closing them fully.

For systems with water-side economizers, maintaining good water quality is paramount to prevent fouling of the heat exchanger or chilled-water system, depending on the type of economizer used.

Check, operate, and enable winterization systems well before freezing temperatures are expected, to allow time to obtain parts and make repairs as necessary. Ensure that sediments do not build up around immersion heater elements, because this will cause rapid failure of the elements.

Maintain sand filters in good order, and inspect the media bed for channeling at least quarterly. If channeling is found, either replace or clean the media as soon as possible. Do not forget to carefully clean the underdrain assembly while the media is removed. If replacing the media, use only that which is specified for cooling towers. Do not use swimming pool filter sand in filters designed for cooling towers and evaporative condensers.

Centrifugal separators rarely require service, although they must not be allowed to overfill with contaminants. Verify proper flow rate, pressure drop, and purge operation.

Check bag and cartridge filters as necessary. Clean the cooling tower if it is dirty.

Cleanliness. Cooling towers are excellent air washers, and the water quality in a given location quickly reflects that of the ambient air (Hensley 1985). A typical 700 kW cooling tower operating 1000 h may assimilate more than 270 kg of particulate matter from airborne dust and the makeup water supply (Broadbent et al. 1992). Proximity to highways and construction sites, air pollution, and operating hours are all factors in cooling tower soil loading.

Design improvements in cooling towers that increase thermal performance also increase air scrubbing capability (Hensley 1985). Recommendations by manufacturers regarding cleaning schedules are, therefore, to be recognized as merely guidelines. The actual frequency of cleanings should be determined at each location by careful observation and system history. Sand filters, bag filters, centrifugal separators, water treatment programs, etc., may not be sufficient to take the place of a physical cleaning. They are designed to improve water quality and the effectiveness of water treatment, as well as help maintain optimal heat transfer surfaces. Recent advancements in cleaning technologies include basin sweeping systems that in many cases can replace physical cleanings. Basin sweeping systems that can be connected to mechanical filtration devices such as separators and sand filters are readily available and offer an excellent means of continuously cleaning cooling tower basins. Depending on basin depth, a flow rate of 0.7 L/(s·m^2) is typically used for sizing basin sweeping systems. Note that regular cleaning of a cooling tower should not be expected to replace water treatment.

Cooling towers should not be allowed to become obviously fouled, but should be cleaned often enough that visible sedimentation and biological activity (algae and slime) are easily controlled by water treatment between cleanings. The tower is the only component in the condenser loop that can be viewed easily without system shutdown, so it should be considered an indicator of total system condition and cleanliness.

Water treatment should not be expected to protect surfaces it cannot reach, such as the metal or wood components under accumulated sediments. Biocides are not likely to be effective unless used in conjunction with a regular cleaning program. Poorly maintained systems create a greater demand on the biocide because organic sediments neutralize the biocide and tend to shield bacterial cells from the chemical, thus requiring higher and more frequent doses to keep microbial populations under control (Broadbent et al. 1992; McCann 1988). High concentrations of an oxidizing biocide can contribute to corrosion. Keeping the cooling tower clean reduces the breeding grounds and nutrients available to the microbial organisms (ASHRAE 1989; Broadbent 1989; Meitz 1986, 1988).

Proper cleaning procedures address the entire cooling tower, including not only the cold-water basin but also the distribution system, strainers, eliminators, casing, fan and fan cylinders, and louvers. The water treatment specialist should be advised and consulted prior to and following the cleaning.

It is recommended that personnel involved wear high-efficiency particulate air (HEPA) type respirators, gloves, goggles, and other body coverings approved by the appropriate agency, such as the U.S. Department of Labor Occupational Health & Safety Administration (OSHA) or National Institute for Occupational Safety and Health (NIOSH) in the United States. This is especially true if the cleaning procedures involve the use of high-pressure water, air, and steam (ASHRAE 1989) or wet/dry vacuum equipment. If any chemicals are used, they must be handled according to their material safety data sheets (MSDSs), available from the chemical supplier.

Operation in Freezing Weather. During operation in freezing weather, the cooling tower should be inspected more frequently, preferably daily, for ice formation on fill, louvers, fans, etc. This is especially true when the system is being operated outside the cooling tower design parameters, such as when the main system is shut down and only supplementary units (e.g., computer cooling equipment) are operating. Ice on fan and drive systems is dangerous and can destroy the fan. Moderate icing on fill and louvers is generally not dangerous but can cause damage if allowed to build up.

In some cases, closed-circuit cooling towers meet load requirements in dry operating mode, thus eliminating the need to spray water over the coils. This allows the basin to be drained. A remote sump or a high dry operation switch point is recommended to better handle unseasonably warm days during winter months. This minimizes the need for system operators to refill the cold-water basin on warmer days and then drain the basin when colder weather returns. Finned coils can also be used to increase the dry operation switch point. Note that the unit fan operates at full speed, drawing 100% of the motor power at the design dry switch point, significantly increasing the fan operating energy (minus the spray pump energy, which is off in this mode). However, when operating in wet mode with spray water over the coils, fan energy is only a small fraction of that required with dry operation.

Follow the manufacturer's specific recommendations both for operation in freezing temperatures and for deicing methods such as low-speed reversal of fan direction for short periods of time. Monitor the operation of winterization equipment, such as immersion heaters and heat-tracing tape on makeup lines, to ensure that they are working properly. Check for conditions that could render the freeze protection inoperable, such as tripped breakers, closed valves, and erroneous temperature settings.

Help from Manufacturers. Equipment manufacturers will provide assistance and technical publications on the efficient operation of their equipment; some even provide training. Also, manufacturers can often provide names of reputable local service companies that are experienced with their equipment. Most of these services are free or of nominal cost.

Water Treatment

The quality of water circulating through an evaporative cooling system significantly affects the overall system efficiency, degree of maintenance required, and useful life of system components.

Because the water is cooled primarily by evaporation of a portion of the circulating water, the concentration of dissolved solids and other impurities in the water can increase rapidly. Also, appreciable quantities of airborne impurities, such as dust and gases, may enter during operation. Depending on the nature of the impurities, they can cause scaling, corrosion, and/or silt deposits.

Simple blowdown (discharge of a small portion of recirculating water to a drain) may be adequate to control scale and corrosion on sites with good-quality makeup water, but it will not control biological contaminants, including *Legionella pneumophila.* All cooling tower systems should be treated to restrict biological growth, and many benefit from treatment to control scale and corrosion. For a complete and detailed description of water treatment, see Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications.* ASHRAE *Standard* 188 and *Guideline* 12 should also be consulted for recommendations regarding control of *Legionella*. Specific recommendations on water treatment, including control of biological contaminants, can be obtained from any qualified water treatment supplier.

White Rust

A common material of construction for factory-assembled cooling towers is galvanized steel. Galvanizing is a process by which steel substrate is protected by a zinc coating for corrosion protection. The zinc coating is applied in a process that alloys the protective coating directly with the steel substrate, providing a mechanical barrier to the environment as well as electrochemical resistance to corrosion. If the zinc coating is breached, the zinc becomes a sacrificial anode providing cathodic corrosion protection of the steel.

Protective zinc surfaces must be treated to form a protective surface layer that reduces chemical activity (passivation) to maintain corrosion protection. Specific water conditions must be met to develop and maintain a passive zinc surface, including pH control, preventing mechanical abrasion by solids, corrosion inhibitors, moderate hardness, and moderate alkalinity. Additional information is available from manufacturers or position papers from organizations such as the Cooling Technology Institute (CTI) and Association of Water Technologies (AWT).

7. PERFORMANCE CURVES

The combination of flow rate and heat load dictates the range a cooling tower must accommodate. The entering air wet-bulb temperature and required system temperature level combine with cooling tower size to balance the heat rejected at a specified approach. The performance curves in this section are typical and may vary from project to project. Computerized selection and rating programs are also available from many manufacturers to generate performance ratings and curves for their equipment.

Cooling towers can accommodate a wide diversity of temperature levels, ranging as high as 65 to 70°C hot-water temperature in the hydrocarbon processing industry. In the air-conditioning and refrigeration industry, cooling towers are generally used in the range of 32 to 46°C hot-water temperature. A typical standard design condition for such cooling towers is 35°C hot water to 29.4°C cold water, and 25.6°C wet-bulb temperature.

A means of evaluating the typical performance of a cooling tower used for a typical air-conditioning system is shown in Figures 26 to 29. The example tower was selected for a flow rate of 54 mL/s per kilowatt when cooling water from 32.5 to 27.5°C at 24°C entering wet-bulb temperature (Figure 32).

When operating at other wet bulbs or ranges, the curves may be interpolated to find the resulting temperature level (hot and cold water) of the system. When operating at other flow rates (36, 72, and 90 mL/s per kilowatt evaporator cooling capacity plus 0.25 kW for compressor cooling), this same cooling tower performs at the levels described by the titles of Figures 33 to 35, respectively. Intermediate flow rates may be interpolated between charts to find resulting operating temperature levels.

The format of these curves is similar to the predicted performance curves supplied by manufacturers of cooling towers; the difference is that only three specific ranges (80%, 100%, and 120% of design range) and only three charts are provided, covering 90%, 100%, and 110% of design flow. The curves in Figures 32 to 35,

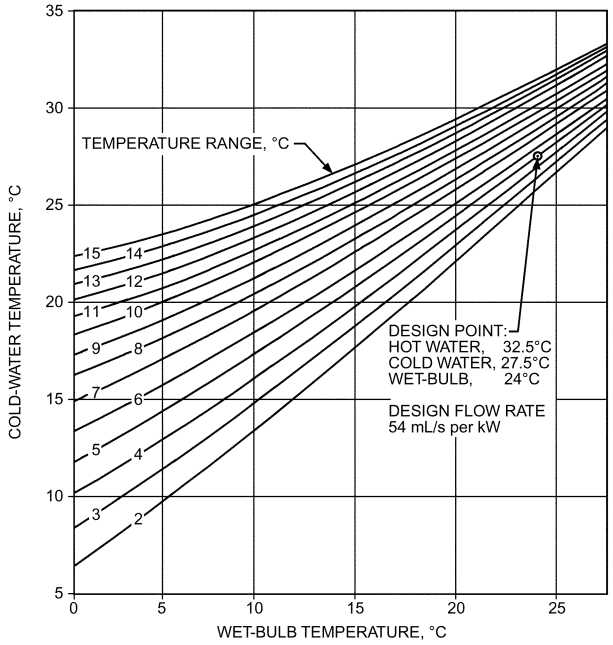

Fig. 32 Cooling Tower Performance: 100% Design Flow

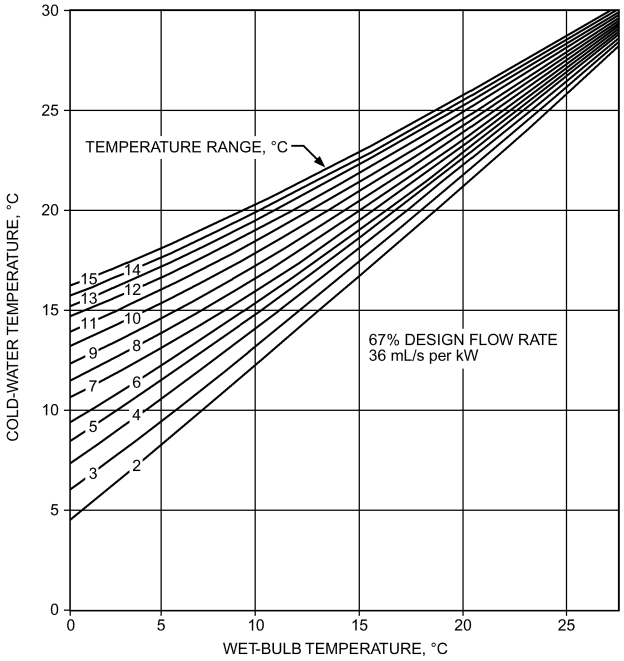

Fig. 33 Cooling Tower Performance: 67% Design Flow

therefore, bracket the acceptable tolerance range of test conditions and may be interpolated for any specific test condition within the scope of the curve families and chart flow rates.

The curves may also be used to identify the feasibility of varying the parameters to meet specific applications. For example, the subject tower can handle a greater heat load (flow rate) when operating in a lower ambient wet-bulb region. This may be seen by comparing the intersection of the 5 K range curve with 21.8°C wet bulb at 27.5°C cold water to show the tower is capable of rejecting 33% more heat load at this lower ambient temperature (Figure 34).

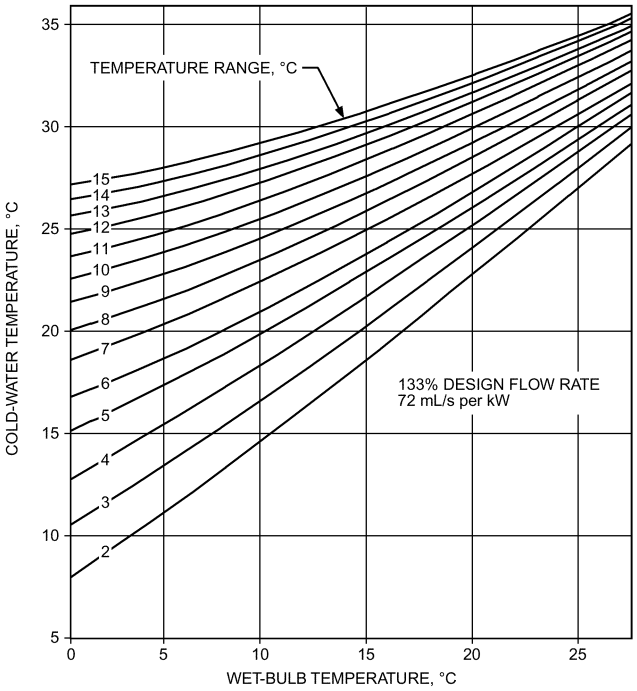

Fig. 34 Cooling Tower Performance: 133% Design Flow

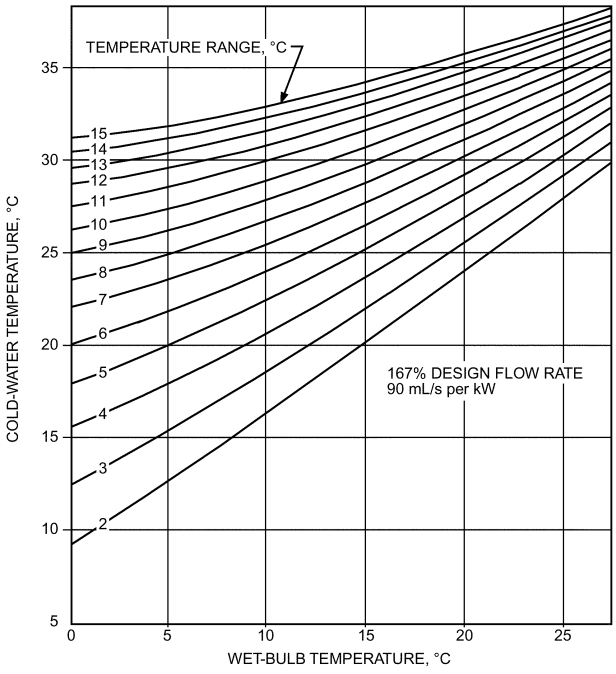

Fig. 35 Cooling Tower Performance: 167% Design Flow

Similar comparisons and cross-plots identify relative cooling tower capacity for a wide range of variables. The curves produce accurate comparisons within the scope of the information presented but should not be extrapolated outside the field of data given. Also, the curves are based on a typical mechanical-draft, film-filled, cross-flow, medium-sized, air-conditioning cooling tower. Other types and sizes of cooling towers produce somewhat different balance points of temperature level. However, the curves may be used to evaluate a tower for year-round or seasonal use if they are restricted to the general operating characteristics described. (See specific manufacturer's data for maximum accuracy when planning for test or critical temperature needs.)

A cooling tower selected for a specified design condition will operate at other temperature levels when the ambient temperature is off-design or when heat load or flow rate varies from the design condition. When flow rate is held constant, range falls as heat load falls, causing temperature levels to fall to a closer approach. Hot- and cold-water temperatures fall when the ambient wet bulb falls at constant heat load, range, and flow rate. As water loading to a particular tower falls at constant ambient wet bulb and range, the tower cools the water to a lower temperature level or closer approach to the wet bulb.

8. COOLING TOWER THERMAL PERFORMANCE

Three basic alternatives are available to a purchaser/designer seeking assurance that a cooling tower will perform as specified: (1) certification of performance by an independent third party such as CTI, (2) an acceptance test performed at the site after the unit is installed, or (3) a performance bond. Codes and standards that pertain to performance certification and field testing of cooling towers are listed in Chapter 51.

Certification. The thermal performance of many commercially available cooling tower lines, both open- and closed-circuit, is certified by CTI in accordance with their *Standard* STD-201, which applies to mechanical-draft, open- and closed-circuit water cooling towers. It is based on entering wet-bulb temperature and certifies cooling tower performance when operating in an open, unrestricted environment. Independent performance certification eliminates the need for field acceptance tests and performance bonds.

Field Acceptance Test. As an alternative to certification, tower performance can be verified after installation by conducting a field acceptance test in accordance with one of the two available test standards. CTI *Standard* ATC-105 is more commonly used, although American Society of Mechanical Engineers (ASME) *Standard* PTC-23 is also accepted. CTI *Standard* ATC-105S is used for thermal performance testing of closed-circuit cooling towers. These standards are similar in their requirements, and both base the performance evaluation on entering wet-bulb temperature. ASME *Standard* PTC-23, however, provides an alternative for evaluation based on ambient wet-bulb temperature as well.

With either procedure, the test consists of measuring the hot-water temperature in the inlet piping to the cooling tower or in the hot-water distribution basin. Preferably, the cold-water temperature is measured at the discharge of the circulating pump, where there is much less chance for temperature stratification. The wet-bulb temperature is measured by an array of mechanically aspirated psychrometers. The recirculating water flow rate is measured by any of several approved methods, usually a pitot-tube traverse of the piping leading to the cooling tower. Recently calibrated instruments

should be used for all measurements, and electronic data acquisition is recommended for all but the smallest installations.

For an accurate test, the tower should be running under a steady heat load combined with a steady flow of recirculating water, both as near design as possible. Weather conditions should be reasonably stable, with prevailing winds of 4.5 m/s or less. The cooling tower should be clean and adjusted for proper water distribution, with all fans operating at design speed. Both CTI and ASME standards specify maximum recommended deviations from design operating conditions of range, flow, wet-bulb temperature, heat load, and fan power.

9. COOLING TOWER THEORY

Baker and Shryock (1961) developed the following theory. Consider a cooling tower having one square metre of plan area; cooling volume V, containing extended water surface per unit volume a; and water mass flow rate L and air mass flow rate G. Figure 36 schematically shows the processes of mass and energy transfer. The bulk water at temperature t is surrounded by the bulk air at dry-bulb temperature t_a, having enthalpy h_a and humidity ratio W_a. The interface is assumed to be a film of saturated air with an intermediate temperature t'', enthalpy h'', and humidity ratio W''. Assuming a constant value of 4.19 kJ/(kg · K) for the specific heat of water c_p, the total energy transfer from the water to the interface is

$$dq_w = Lc_p\,dt = K_L a(t - t'')dV \tag{4}$$

where

q_w = rate of total heat transfer, bulk water to interface, W
L = inlet water mass flow rate, kg/s
K_L = unit conductance, heat transfer, bulk water to interface, W/(m^2 · K)
V = cooling volume, m^3
a = area of interface, /m^2/m^3

The heat transfer from interface to air is

$$dq_s = K_G a(t'' - t_a)dV \tag{5}$$

where

q_s = rate of sensible heat transfer, interface to airstream, W
K_G = overall unit conductance, sensible heat transfer, interface to main airstream, W/(m^2 · K)

The diffusion of water vapor from film to air is

$$dm = K'a(W'' - W_a)dV \tag{6}$$

where

m = mass transfer rate, interface to airstream, kg/s
K' = unit conductance, mass transfer, interface to main airstream, kg/(s · m^2)
W'' = humidity ratio of interface (film), kg/kg
W_a = humidity ratio of air, kg/kg

The heat transfer caused by evaporation from film to air is

$$dq_L = r\,dm = rK'a(W'' - W_a)dV \tag{7}$$

where

q_L = rate of latent heat transfer, interface to airstream, W
r = latent heat of evaporation (constant), kJ/kg

The process reaches equilibrium when $t_a = t$, and the air becomes saturated with moisture at that temperature. Under adiabatic conditions, equilibrium is reached at the temperature of adiabatic saturation or at the thermodynamic wet-bulb temperature of the air. This is the lowest attainable temperature in a cooling tower. The circulating water rapidly approaches this temperature when a tower operates without heat load. The process is the same when a heat load is applied, but the air enthalpy increases as it moves through the tower so the equilibrium temperature increases progressively.

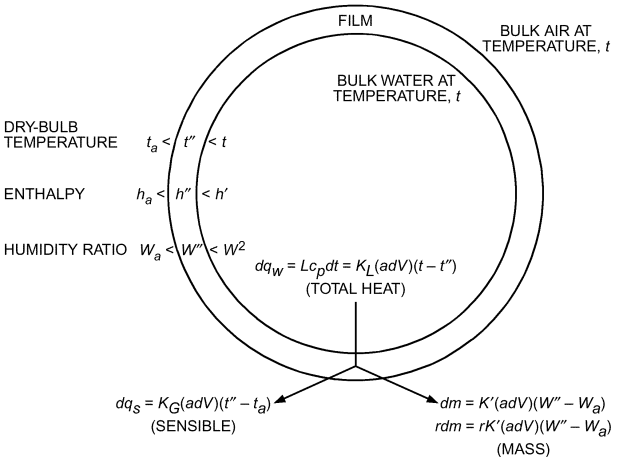

Fig. 36 Heat and Mass Transfer Relationships Between Water, Interfacial Film, and Air

(Baker and Shryock 1961)

The approach of the cooled water to the entering wet-bulb temperature is a function of the tower's capability.

Merkel (1925) assumed the Lewis relationship to be equal to one in combining the transfer of mass and sensible heat into an overall coefficient based on enthalpy difference as the driving force:

$$K_G/(K'c_{pm}) = 1 \tag{8}$$

where c_{pm} is the humid specific heat of moist air in J/(kg · K) (dry air basis).

Equation (7) also explains why the wet-bulb thermometer closely approximates the temperature of adiabatic saturation in an air-water vapor mixture. Setting water heat loss equal to air heat gain yields

$$Lc_p\,dt = G\,dh = K'a(h'' - h_a)dV \tag{9}$$

where G is the air mass flow rate in kg/s.

The equation considers the transfer from the interface to the airstream, but the interfacial conditions are indeterminate. If the film resistance is neglected and an overall coefficient K' is postulated, based on the driving force of enthalpy h' at the bulk water temperature t, the equation becomes

$$Lc_p\,dt = G\,dh = K'a(h' - h_a)dV \tag{10}$$

or

$$K'aV/L = \int_{t_1}^{t_2} \frac{c_p}{h' - h_a}\,dt \tag{11}$$

and

$$K'aV/G = \int_{h_1}^{h_2} \frac{dh}{h' - h_a} \tag{12}$$

In cooling tower practice, the integrated value of Equation (10) is commonly referred to as the **number of transfer units (NTU)**. This value gives the number of times the average enthalpy potential $(h' - h_a)$ goes into the temperature change of the water (Δt) and is a measure of the difficulty of the task. Thus, one transfer unit has the definition of $c_p\Delta t/(h' - h_a)_{avg} = 1$.

The equations are not self-sufficient and are not subject to direct mathematical solution. They reflect mass and energy balance at any point in a tower and are independent of relative motion of the two fluid streams. Mechanical integration is required to apply the equations, and the procedure must account for relative motion. Integration of Equation (10) gives the NTU for a given set of conditions.

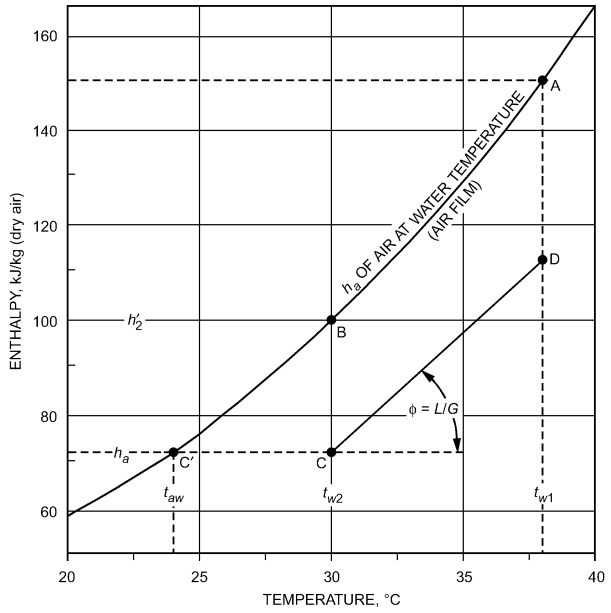

Fig. 37 Counterflow Cooling Diagram

Counterflow Integration

The counterflow cooling diagram is based on the saturation curve for air-water vapor (Figure 37). As water is cooled from t_{w1} to t_{w2}, the air film enthalpy follows the saturation curve from A to B. Air entering at wet-bulb temperature t_{aw} has an enthalpy h_a corresponding to C′. The initial driving force is the vertical distance BC. Heat removed from the water is added to the air, so the enthalpy increase is proportional to water temperature. The slope of the air operating line CD equals L/G.

Counterflow calculations start at the bottom of a cooling tower, the only point where the air and water conditions are known. The NTU is calculated for a series of incremental steps, and the summation is the integral of the process.

Example 1. Air enters the base of a counterflow cooling tower at 24°C wet-bulb temperature, water leaves at 30°C, and L/G (water-to-air ratio) is 1.2, so $dh = 1.2 \times 4.18 \times dt$, where 4.18 kJ/(kg·K) is the specific heat c_p of water. Calculate the NTU for various cooling ranges.

Solution: The calculation is shown in Table 1. Water temperatures are shown in column 1 for 0.5 K increments from 30 to 33°C and 1 K increments from 33 to 38°C. The corresponding film enthalpies, obtained from psychrometric tables, are shown in column 2.

The upward air path is shown in column 3. The initial air enthalpy is 72.40 kJ/kg, corresponding to a 24°C wet bulb, and increases by the relationship $\Delta h = 1.2 \times 4.18 \times \Delta t$.

The driving force $h' - h_a$ at each increment is listed in column 4. The reciprocals $1/(h' - h_a)$ are calculated (column 5), Δt is noted (column 6), and the average for each increment is multiplied by $c_p \Delta t$ to obtain the NTU for each increment (column 7). The summation of the incremental values (column 8) represents the NTU for the summation of the incremental temperature changes, which is the cooling range given in column 9.

Because of the slope and position of CD relative to the saturation curve, the potential difference increases progressively from the bottom to the top of the tower in this example. The degree of difficulty decreases as this driving force increases, reflected as a reduction in the incremental NTU proportional to a variation in incremental height. This procedure determines the temperature gradient with respect to cooling tower height.

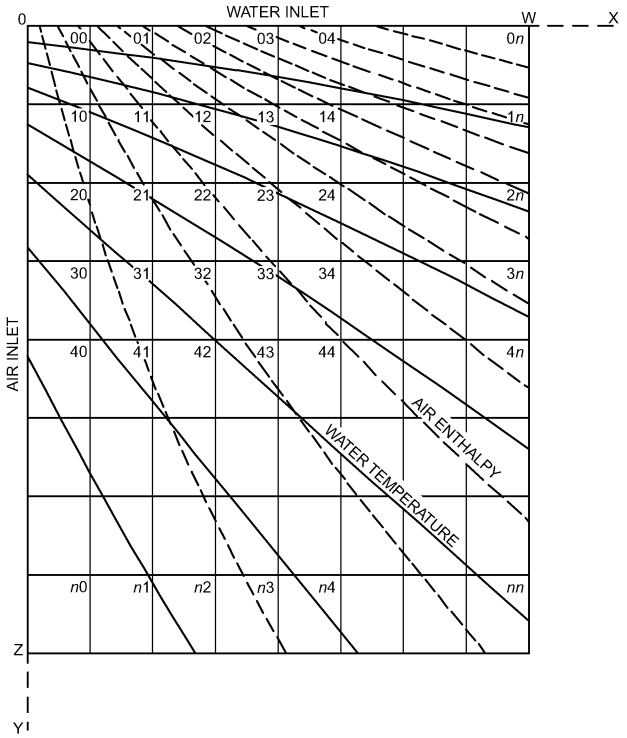

Fig. 38 Water Temperature and Air Enthalpy Variation Through Cross-Flow Cooling Tower

(Baker and Shryock 1961)

The procedure of Example 1 considers increments of temperature change and calculates the coincident values of NTU, which correspond to increments of height. Baker and Mart (1952) developed a unit-volume procedure that considers increments of NTU (representing increments of height) with corresponding temperature changes calculated by iteration. The unit-volume procedure is more cumbersome but is necessary in cross-flow integration because it accounts for temperature and enthalpy change, both horizontally and vertically.

Cross-Flow Integration

In a cross-flow tower, water enters at the top; the solid lines of constant water temperature in Figure 38 show its temperature distribution. Air enters from the left, and the dashed lines show constant enthalpies. The cross section is divided into unit volumes in which dV becomes $dx\,dy$ and Equation (9) becomes

$$c_p L\,dt\,dx = G\,dh\,dy = Ka(h' - h_a)\,dx\,dy \tag{13}$$

The overall L/G ratio applies to each unit volume by considering $dx/dy = w/z$. The cross-sectional shape is automatically considered when an equal number of horizontal and vertical increments are used. Calculations start at the top of the air inlet and proceed down and across. Typical calculations are shown in Figure 39 for water entering at 50°C, air entering at 24°C wet-bulb temperature, and $L/G = 1.0$. Each unit volume represents 0.1 NTU. Temperature change vertically in each unit is determined by iteration from

$$\Delta t = 0.1(h' - h_a)_{avg} \tag{14}$$

The expression $c_p(L/G)dt = dh$ determines the horizontal change in air enthalpy. With each step representing 0.1 NTU, two steps down and across equal 0.2 NTU, etc., for conditions corresponding to the average leaving water temperature.

Table 1 Counterflow Integration Calculations for Example 1

1 Water Temperature t, °C	2 Enthalpy of Film h', kJ/kg	3 Enthalpy of Air h_a, kJ/kg	4 Enthalpy Difference $h' - h_a$, kJ/kg	5 $\frac{1}{(h' - h_a)}$	6 Δt, K	7 $\text{NTU} = \frac{c_p \Delta t}{(h' - h_a)_{avg}}$	8 ΣNTU	9 Cumulative Cooling Range, K
30	100.0	72.40	27.60	0.0362				
					0.5	0.0755	0.0755	0.5
30.5	102.7	74.91	27.79	0.0360				
					0.5	0.0749	0.1504	1
31	105.4	77.42	27.98	0.0357				
					0.5	0.0743	0.2247	1.5
31.5	108.2	79.92	28.28	0.0354				
					0.5	0.0735	0.2982	2
32	111.0	82.43	28.57	0.0350				
					0.5	0.0727	0.3709	2.5
32.5	113.9	84.94	28.96	0.0345				
					0.5	0.0716	0.4425	3
33	116.9	87.45	29.45	0.0334				
					1	0.1394	0.5819	4
34	123.0	92.46	30.54	0.0327				
					1	0.1337	0.7156	5
35	129.5	97.48	32.02	0.0312				
					1	0.1273	0.8429	6
36	136.2	102.50	33.70	0.0297				
					1	0.1204	0.9633	7
37	143.3	107.51	35.79	0.0279				
					1	0.1132	1.0764	8
38	150.7	112.53	38.17	0.0262				

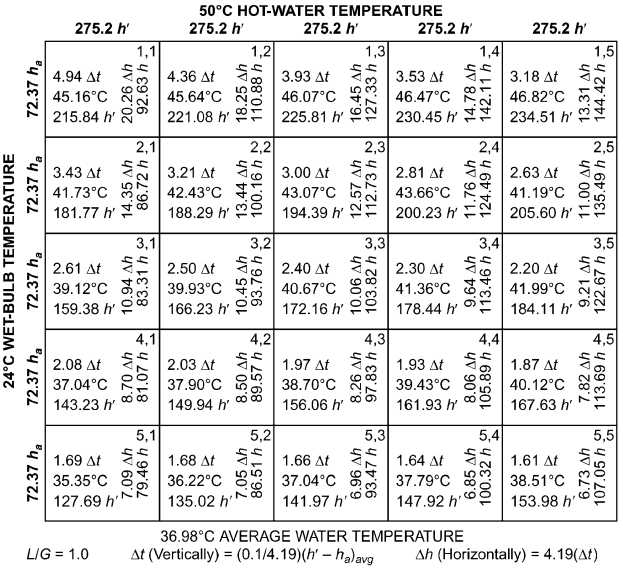

Fig. 39 Cross-Flow Calculations

(Baker and Shryock 1961)

Figure 38 shows that air flowing across any horizontal plane moves toward progressively hotter water, with entering hot-water temperature as a limit. Water falling through any vertical section moves toward progressively colder air that has the entering wet-bulb temperature as a limit. This is shown in Figure 40, which is a plot of the data in Figure 39. Air enthalpy follows the family of curves radiating from Point A. Air moving across the top of the cooling tower tends to coincide with OA. Air flowing across the bottom of a tower of infinite height follows a curve that coincides with the saturation curve AB.

Water temperatures follow the family of curves radiating from Point B, between the limits of BO at the air inlet and BA at the outlet of a tower of infinite width. The single operating line CD of the counterflow diagram in Figure 37 is replaced in the cross-flow diagram (Figure 40) by a zone represented by the area intersected by the two families of curves.

10. TOWER COEFFICIENTS

Calculations can reduce a set of conditions to a numerical value representing degree of difficulty. The NTU corresponding to a set of hypothetical conditions is called the **required coefficient** and evaluates degree of difficulty. When test results are being considered, the NTU represents the available coefficient and becomes an evaluation of the equipment tested.

The calculations consider temperatures and the *L/G* ratio. The minimum required coefficient for a given set of temperatures occurs at $L/G = 0$, corresponding to an infinite air rate. Air enthalpy does not increase, so the driving force is maximum and the degree of difficulty is minimum. Decreased air rate (increase in *L/G*) decreases the driving force, and the greater degree of difficulty shows as an increase in NTU. This situation is shown for counterflow in Figure 41. Maximum *L/G* (minimum air rate) occurs when CD intersects the saturation curve. Driving force becomes zero, and NTU is infinite. The point of zero driving force may occur at the air outlet or at an intermediate point because of the curvature of the saturation curve.

Similar variations occur in cross-flow cooling. Variations in *L/G* vary the shape of the operating area. At $L/G = 0$, the operating area becomes a horizontal line, which is identical to the counterflow diagram (Figure 41), and both coefficients are the same. An increase in *L/G* increases the height of the operating area and decreases the width. This continues as the areas extend to Point A as a limit. This maximum *L/G* always occurs when the wet-bulb temperature of the air equals the hot-water temperature and not at an intermediate point, as may occur in counterflow.

Both types of flow have the same minimum coefficient at $L/G = 0$, and both increase to infinity at a maximum *L/G*. The maximums are the same if the counterflow potential reaches zero at the air outlet, but the counterflow tower will have a lower maximum *L/G* when the potential reaches zero at an intermediate point, as in Figure 41. A cooling tower can be designed to operate at any point within the two limits, but most applications restrict the design to much narrower limits determined by air velocity.

A low air rate requires a large tower, while a high air rate in a smaller tower requires greater fan power. Typical limits in air velocity are about 1.5 to 3.6 m/s in counterflow and 1.8 to 4 m/s or more in cross flow.

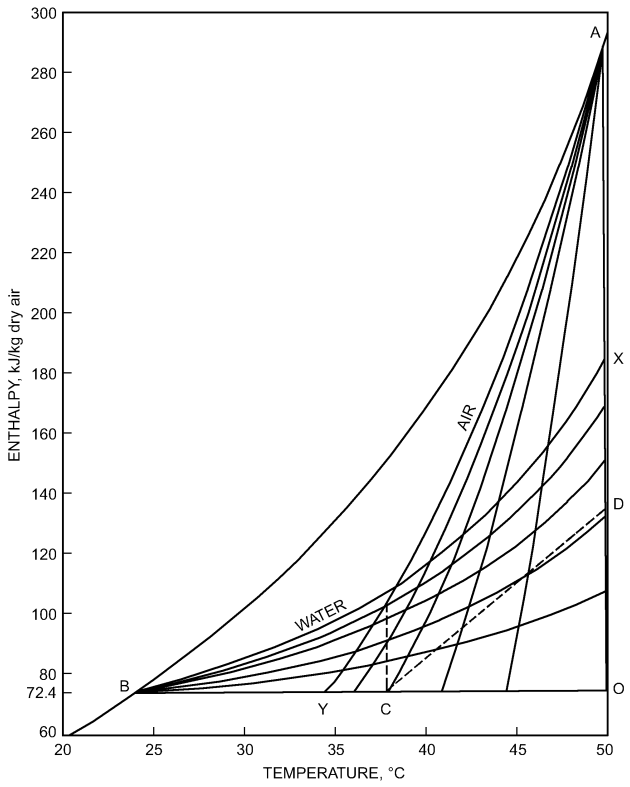

Fig. 40 Cross-Flow Cooling Diagram

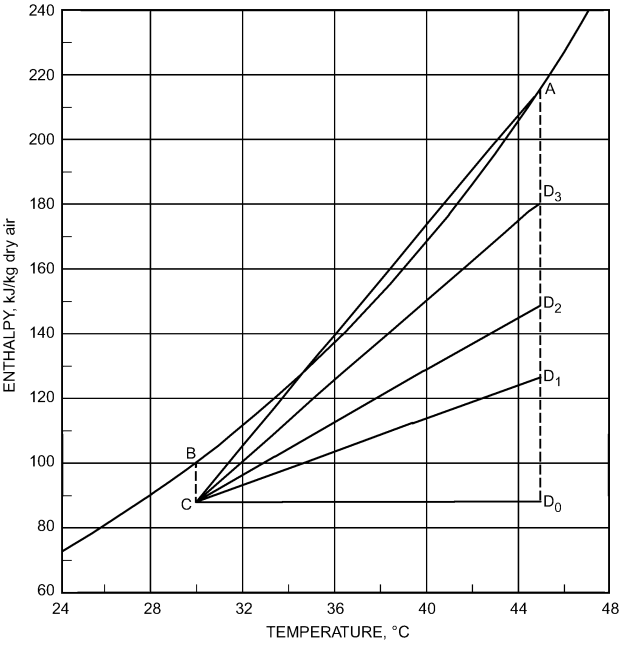

Fig. 41 Counterflow Cooling Diagram for Constant Conditions, Variable *L*/*G* Ratios

Available Coefficients

A cooling tower can operate over a wide range of water rates, air rates, and heat loads, with variation in the approach of the cold water to the wet-bulb temperature. Analysis of a series of test points shows that the available coefficient is not a constant but varies with operating conditions, as shown in Figure 42.

Figure 42 is a typical correlation of a tower characteristic showing the variation of available KaV/L with L/G for parameters of constant air velocity. Recent fill developments and more accurate test methods have shown that some of the characteristic lines are curves rather than a series of straight, parallel lines on logarithmic coordinates.

Ignoring the minor effect of air velocity, a single average curve may be considered:

$$KaV/L \sim (L/G)'' \tag{15}$$

The exponent n varies over a range of about –0.35 to –1.1 but averages between –0.55 and –0.65. Within the range of testing, –0.6 has been considered sufficiently accurate.

The family of curves corresponds to the following relation:

$$KaV/L \sim (L)^n (G)^m \tag{16}$$

where m varies slightly from n numerically and is a positive exponent.

The triangular points in Figure 42 show the effect of varying temperature at nominal air rate. The deviations result from simplifying assumptions and may be overcome by modifying the integration procedure. Usual practice, as shown in Equation (11), ignores evaporation and assumes that

$$G\,dh = c_p L\,dt \tag{17}$$

The exact enthalpy rise is greater than this because a portion of the heat in the water stream leaves as vapor in the airstream. The correct heat balance is as follows (Baker and Shryock 1961):

$$G\,dh = c_p L\,dt + c_p L_E (t_{w2}) \tag{18}$$

where L_E is the mass flow rate of water that evaporates, in kg/s. This reduces the driving force and increases the NTU.

Evaporation causes the water rate to decrease from L at the inlet to $L - L_E$ at the outlet. The water-to-air ratio varies from L/G at the water inlet to $(L - L_E)/G$ at the outlet. This results in an increased NTU.

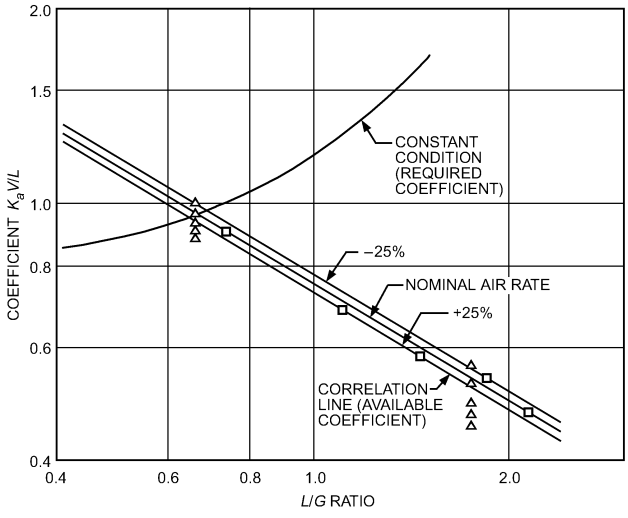

Fig. 42 Tower Characteristic, *KaV*/*L* Versus *L*/*G*

(Baker and Shryock 1961)

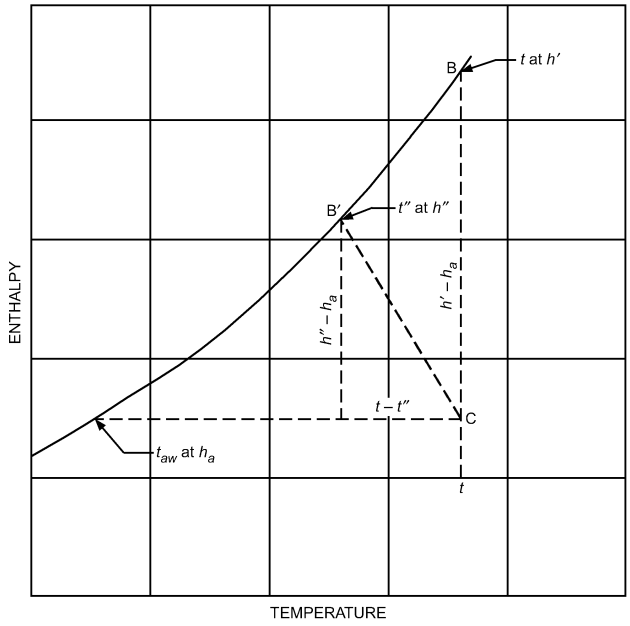

Fig. 43 True Versus Apparent Potential Difference

(Baker and Shryock 1961)

Basic theory considers the transfer from the interface to the airstream. As the film conditions are indeterminate, film resistance is neglected as assumed in Equation (9). The resulting coefficients show deviations closely associated with hot-water temperature and may be modified by an empirical hot-water correction factor (Baker and Mart 1952).

The effect of film resistance (Mickley 1949) is shown in Figure 43. Water at temperature t is assumed to be surrounded by a film of saturated air at the same temperature at enthalpy h' (Point B on the saturation curve). The film is actually at a lower temperature t'' at enthalpy h'' (Point B′). The surrounding air at enthalpy h_a corresponds to Point C. The apparent potential difference is commonly considered to be $h' - h_a$, but the true potential difference is $h'' - h_a$ (Mickley 1949). From Equations (1) and (8),

$$\frac{h'' - h_a}{t - t''} = \frac{K_L}{K'} \tag{19}$$

The slope of CB′ is the ratio of the two coefficients. No means to evaluate the coefficients has been proposed, but a slope of –11.1 for cross-flow towers has been reported (Baker and Shryock 1961).

Establishing Tower Characteristics

The performance characteristic of a fill pattern can vary widely because of several external factors. For a given volume of fill, the optimal thermal performance is obtained with uniform air and water distribution throughout the fill pack. Irregularities in either alter the local *L/G* ratios within the pack and adversely affect the overall thermal performance of the cooling tower. Accordingly, the design of the cooling tower water distribution system, air inlets, fan plenum, and so forth is very important in ensuring that the tower performs to its potential.

In counterflow towers, some cooling occurs in the spray chamber above the fill and in the open space below the fill. This additional performance is erroneously attributed to the fill itself, which can lead to inaccurate predictions of a cooling tower's performance in other applications. A true performance characteristic for the total cooling tower can only be developed from full-scale tests of the actual cooling tower assembly, typically by the tower manufacturer, and not by combining performance data of individual components.

11. ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

The Cooling Technology Institute (CTI) (www.CTI.org) offers a reference guide on CD-ROM containing information on psychrometrics, Merkel *KaV/L* calculation, characteristic curve performance evaluation, and performance curve evaluation, along with general information on cooling towers of all types.

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CHAPTER 41

EVAPORATIVE AIR-COOLING EQUIPMENT

Direct Evaporative Air Coolers 41.1
Indirect Evaporative Air Coolers 41.3
Indirect/Direct Combinations 41.5
Air Washers 41.7
Humidification/Dehumidification 41.8
Sound Attenuation 41.9
Maintenance and Water Treatment 41.9
VAV Adiabatic Humidification with Heat Recovery Economizer 41.10
Cold-Climate Adiabatic Humidification 41.11

THIS chapter addresses direct and indirect evaporative equipment, air washers, and their associated equipment used for air cooling, humidification, dehumidification, air cleaning, and variable-air-volume (VAV) adiabatic humidification with heat recovery economizers. Humidification equipment for residential and industrial applications is covered in Chapter 22.

Principal advantages of evaporative air conditioning include

- Substantial energy and cost savings
- Reduced peak power demand
- Improved indoor air quality
- Life-cycle cost effectiveness
- Easily integrated into built-up systems
- Wide variety of packages available
- Provides humidification and dehumidification when needed
- Easy to use with direct digital control (DDC)
- Reduced pollution emissions
- No use of chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs)
- For same amount of cooling, less water is evaporated than with conventional air conditioning
- Sound attenuation

Packaged direct evaporative air coolers, air washers, indirect evaporative air coolers, evaporative condensers, vacuum cooling apparatus, and cooling towers exchange sensible heat for latent heat. This equipment falls into two general categories: those for (1) air cooling and (2) heat rejection. This chapter addresses equipment used for air cooling.

Adiabatic evaporation of water provides the cooling effect of evaporative air conditioning. In **direct evaporative cooling**, water evaporates directly into the airstream, reducing the air's dry-bulb temperature and raising its humidity level. Direct evaporative equipment cools air by direct contact with the water, either by an extended wetted-surface material (e.g., packaged air coolers) or with a series of sprays (e.g., an air washer).

With **indirect evaporative cooling**, secondary air removes heat from primary air using a heat exchanger. In one indirect method, water is evaporatively cooled by a cooling tower and circulates through one side of a heat exchanger. Supply air to the space passes over the other side of the heat exchanger. In another common method, one side of an air-to-air heat exchanger is wetted and removes heat from the conditioned supply airstream on the dry side. Even in regions with high wet-bulb temperatures, indirect evaporative cooling can be economically feasible. This is especially true if building return air from an air-conditioned building is used on the wet side of an air-to-air heat exchanger. The return air's lower wet-bulb temperature, which derives from mechanical refrigeration, may be used to extend indirect evaporative cooling performance in more humid climates.

To improve system performance, it is often desirable to combine the effects of both indirect (dry) and direct (adiabatic) evaporative cooling. When indirect cooling is called for as the first stage of cooling, outdoor air is sensibly cooled and the ambient wet-bulb temperature is reduced. At this new, lower wet-bulb condition, the direct evaporative cooler (second stage) can generate a lower delivery dry-bulb temperature. If a final cooling stage of refrigeration is required to achieve a 13°C building variable-air-volume (VAV) delivery temperature, final-stage cooling capacity may be greatly reduced when compared to an air-side economizer with 25% minimum outdoor air. In semiarid climates, where most ambient dew-point conditions are below 13°C, two-stage indirect/direct evaporative cooling may reduce peak building demand by 25 to 30% and kilowatt-hours of cooling by 50 to 60%. During cooling hours, the indirect/direct cooling system provides 100% outdoor air to the building for better indoor air quality (IAQ).

Using building return air on the secondary (wet) side of a directly sprayed air-to-air heat exchanger has other benefits. With a 13°C VAV building delivery set-point temperature, return air wet-bulb temperatures are commonly between 16 and 18°C because of building moisture capacitance. In summer, using building return air wet bulb for indirect evaporative cooling ensures higher sensible cooling from the indirect cooling heat exchanger, especially in climates where ambient wet-bulb excursions above 18°C are frequent. In winter, when the air-to-air heat exchanger water sprays are off, a building return air dry-bulb condition of 21 to 24°C may be used for heat recovery from outdoor air. VAV systems, which experience reduced outdoor air as supply fans turn down, can provide a higher percentage of outdoor air to comply with ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 without added heating costs.

Direct evaporative coolers for residences in low-wet-bulb regions typically require 70% less energy than direct-expansion air conditioners. For instance, in El Paso, Texas, the typical evaporative cooler consumes 609 kWh per cooling season, compared to 3901 kWh per season for a typical vapor-compression air conditioner with a seasonal energy-efficiency ratio (SEER) of 10. This equates to an average demand of 0.51 kW based on 1200 operating hours, compared to an average of 3.25 kW for a vapor-compression air conditioner.

Depending on climatic conditions, many buildings can use indirect/direct evaporative air conditioning to provide comfort cooling. Indirect/direct systems achieve a 40 to 50% energy savings in moderate humidity zones (Foster and Dijkstra 1996).

1. DIRECT EVAPORATIVE AIR COOLERS

With direct evaporative air cooling, air is passed through porous wetted pads or a spray, and its sensible heat energy evaporates some water. Heat and mass transfer between the air and water results in an adiabatic process that lowers the dry-bulb temperature while increasing the air's moisture content (the wet-bulb temperature remains nearly constant). The dry-bulb temperature of the nearly saturated air approaches the ambient air's wet-bulb temperature.

Saturation effectiveness is a key factor in determining evaporative cooler performance. The extent to which the leaving air temperature from a direct evaporative cooler approaches the thermodynamic wet-

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 5.7, Evaporative Cooling.

bulb temperature of the entering air defines the **direct saturation efficiency** ε_e, expressed as

$$\varepsilon_e = 100 \frac{t_1 - t_2}{t_1 - t_s'} \quad (1)$$

where

ε_e = direct evaporative cooling saturation efficiency, %
t_1 = dry-bulb temperature of entering air, °C
t_2 = dry-bulb temperature of leaving air, °C
t_s' = thermodynamic wet-bulb temperature of entering air, °C

An efficient wetted pad (with high saturation efficiency) can reduce the air dry-bulb temperature by as much as 95% of the wet-bulb depression (ambient dry-bulb temperature less wet-bulb temperature), although an inefficient and poorly designed pad may only reduce this by 50% or less.

Although direct evaporative cooling is simple and inexpensive, its cooling effect is not applicable for indoor comfort when the ambient wet-bulb temperature is higher than about 21°C; however, this cooling is satisfactory for relief cooling applications (e.g., greenhouses, industrial cooling). Direct evaporative coolers should not recirculate indoor air; exhaust should equal incoming conditioned air.

Random-Media Air Coolers

These coolers contain evaporative pads, usually of aspen wood or absorbent plastic fiber/foam (Figure 1). A water-recirculating pump lifts sump water to a distributing system, and it flows down through the pads back to the sump.

A fan in the cooler draws air through the evaporative pads and delivers it for space cooling. The fan discharges either through the side of the cooler cabinet or through the sump bottom. Random-media packaged air coolers are made as small tabletop coolers (0.02 to 0.09 m^3/s), window units (0.05 to 2.1 m^3/s), and standard duct-connected coolers (2.4 to 8.5 m^3/s). Cooler selection is based on a capacity rating from an independent agency.

When clean and well maintained, commercial random-media air coolers operate at approximately 80% effectiveness and reduce the concentration of 10 μm and larger particles in the air. In some units, supplementary filters are added to reduce the particle count of delivered air when the unit is operating with or without water circulation. Evaporative pads may be chemically treated to increase wettability. An additive may be included in the fibers to help them resist attack by bacteria, fungi, and other microorganisms.

Random-media cooler designs with face velocity of 0.5 to 1.3 m/s with a pressure drop of 25 Pa are the norm. Aspen fibers packed to approximately 1.5 to 2 kg/m^2 of face area, based on a 50 mm thick pad, are standard. Pads mount in removable louvered frames, which are usually made of painted galvanized steel or molded plastic. Troughs distribute water to the pads. A centrifugal pump with a submerged inlet delivers water through tubes that provide an equal flow of water to each trough. It is important that the pump motor be thermally protected. The sump or water tank has a water makeup connection, float valve, overflow pipe, and drain. It is important to provide bleed water or a timed dump of the sump (or both) to prevent build-up of minerals, dirt, and microbial growth.

The fan is usually a forward-curved, centrifugal fan, complete with motor and drive. The V-belt drive may include an adjustable-pitch motor sheave to allow fan speed to increase to use the full motor capacity at higher airflow resistance. The motor enclosure may be drip-proof, totally enclosed, or a semi-open type specifically designed for evaporative coolers.

Rigid-Media Air Coolers

Blocks of corrugated material make up the wetted surface of rigid-media direct evaporative air coolers (Figure 2). Materials include cellulose, plastic, and fiberglass, treated to absorb water and resist weathering effects. The medium is cross corrugated to maximize mixing of air and water. In the direction of airflow, the depth of medium is commonly 300 mm, but it may be between 100 and 600 mm, depending on the desired thermal performance. The medium has the desirable characteristics of low resistance to airflow, high saturation effectiveness, and self-cleaning abilities. The standard design face velocity of a rigid medium is 2 to 3 m/s. Static pressure loss for a 300 mm media pad varies from 34.8 to 74.6 Pa at sea level.

Direct evaporative air coolers using this material can handle as much as 280 m^3/s and may include an integral fan. Saturation effectiveness varies from 70 to over 95%, depending on media depth and air velocity. Air flows horizontally while the recirculating water flows vertically over the medium surfaces by gravity feed from a flooding header and water distribution chamber. The header may be connected directly to a pressurized water supply for once-through operation (e.g., gas turbines, cleanrooms, data centers), or a pump may recirculate the water from a lower reservoir constructed of heavy-gage corrosion-resistant material. The reservoir is also fitted with overflow and positive-flowing drain connections. The upper media enclosure is of reinforced galvanized steel or other corrosion-resistant sheet metal, or of plastic.

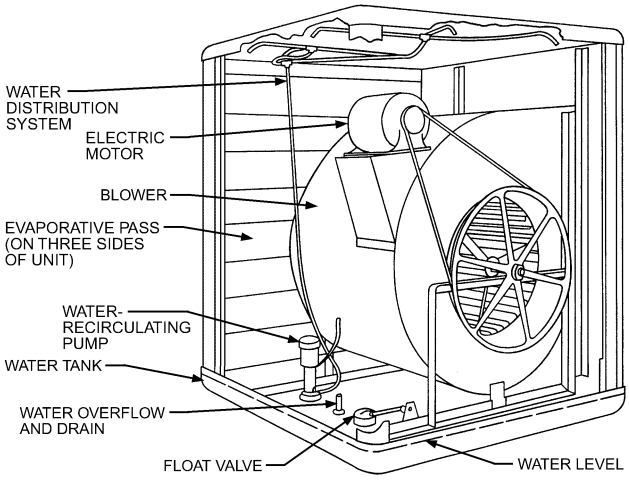


Fig. 1 Typical Random-Media Evaporative Cooler

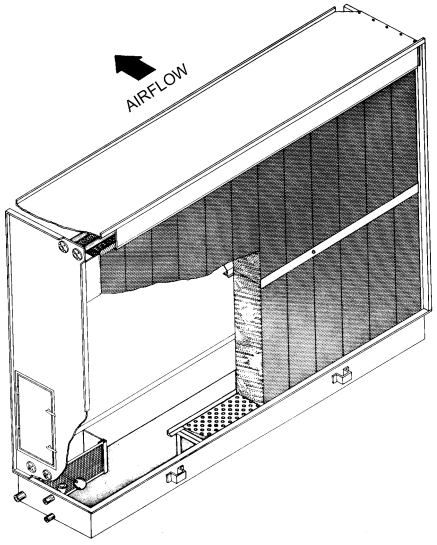


Fig. 2 Typical Rigid-Media Air Cooler

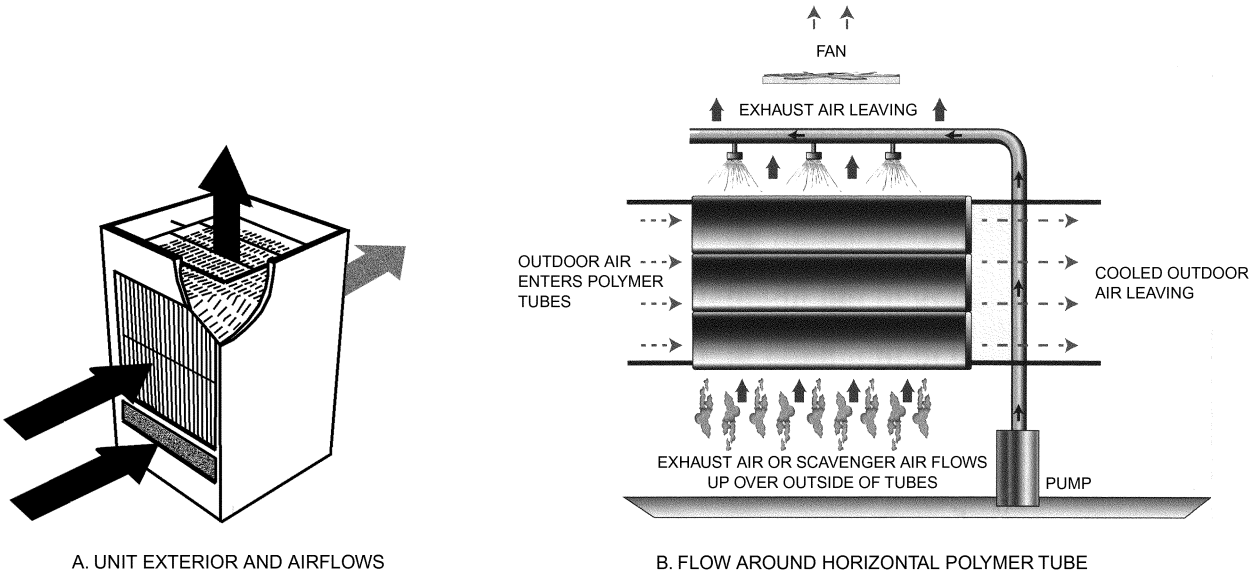


Fig. 3 Indirect Evaporative Cooling (IEC) Heat Exchanger

(Courtesy Munters/Des Champs)

Flanges at the entering and leaving faces allow connection of ductwork. In recirculating water systems, a float valve maintains proper water level in the reservoir, makes up water that has evaporated, and supplies fresh water for dilution to prevent an overconcentration of solids and minerals. Because the water recirculation rate is low and high-pressure nozzles are not needed to saturate the medium, pumping power is low compared to spray-filled air washers with equivalent evaporative cooling effectiveness.

Remote Pad Evaporative Cooling Equipment

Greenhouses, poultry or hog buildings, and similar applications use exhaust fans installed in the wall or roof of the structure. Air evaporatively cools as it flows through pads located on the other end of the building. Water flowing down from a perforated pipe wets the pads, with excess water collected for recirculation. In some cases, the pads are wetted with high-pressure fogging nozzles, which provide additional cooling. Water for fogging nozzles must come directly from the fresh-water supply. The pad has an air velocity of approximately 0.8 m/s for random-media pads, 1.3 m/s for 100 mm rigid media, and 2.2 m/s for 150 mm rigid media.

2. INDIRECT EVAPORATIVE AIR COOLERS

Packaged Indirect Evaporative Air Coolers

Figure 3 shows an indirect evaporative cooling (IEC) heat exchanger using elliptical shaped polymer tubes installed horizontally. Either outdoor or recirculated air may be cooled using IEC; commercial IEC commonly cools outdoor air, often as part of a dedicated outdoor-air system (DOAS) or VAV air-handler design, whereas in industrial applications and data center cooling designs, process recirculation air is more commonly cooled. Air delivered to the room or process flows through the inside of the tubes, where it is sensibly cooled. A sump pump recirculates water over the outside of the polymer tubes of this cross-flow air-to-air heat exchanger. Scavenger outdoor air or building return/exhaust air (typical for commercial applications) is drawn upward over the exterior of the wetted polymer tubes.

The airfoil elliptical shape of the tube exterior maximizes the heat transfer surface area. Sensible heat from process air flowing inside the tubes is transferred through the thin polymer tube wall into the water film flowing over the exterior of the tubes. The water is cooled by evaporation as the scavenger air flows over the wetted tube exterior. The scavenger air, along with the extracted heat, is finally discharged to ambient. Process air inside the tubes may be dehumidified whenever the wet-bulb temperature of the scavenger air is below the dew-point temperature of the process air.

As water evaporates on the exterior of the tubes, it is normal for some minerals in the water to be deposited onto the tube walls. Fortunately, the ribbed exterior of properly design polymer tubes resists mineral adhesion. Also, elliptical polymer tubes are elastic enough that normal fan operation for supply and scavenger air flexes the tubes, helping them shed scale accumulations and minimizing fouling so as not to adversely affect IEC performance.

Polymer tube heat exchangers can provide a 60 to 80% approach of the dry-side entering dry bulb temperature to the wet-side entering wet bulb temperature. The heat exchanger efficiency calculation is called **wet-bulb depression efficiency (WBDE)** and is defined as

$$\text{WBDE} = 100\frac{(t_1 - t_2)}{(t_1 - t_s')} \tag{2}$$

where

WBDE = wet-bulb depression efficiency, %
t_1 = dry-bulb temperature of entering primary air, °C
t_2 = dry-bulb temperature of leaving primary air, °C
t_s' = wet-bulb temperature of entering secondary air, °C

Supply-air-side static pressure losses for these heat exchangers range from 60 to 185 Pa. Wet-side airflow pressure drop penalties range from 100 to 225 Pa. Secondary airflow ratios are in the range of 1.5 to 1 down to a low of 0.5 L/s of outdoor air (OA) to 0.3 L/s of secondary airflow. The higher the ratios of wet-side air to dry air, the greater the WBDE, with all other factors remaining constant. Cooling energy efficiency ratios (EER) for this type of heat exchanger range from 40 to 80.

With DX Refrigeration. Figure 4 shows a package unit design that combines the tube-type indirect evaporative cooling heat exchanger with a direct-expansion (DX) refrigeration final stage of cooling. The geometry of the tube-type heat exchanger usually limits the size of this application to less than 23.6 m^3/s of supply air for complete packaged systems. There is no airflow limit for stand-alone tube-type IEC heat exchangers that are banked together (e.g., in a mechanical room on the outer wall of a large data center).

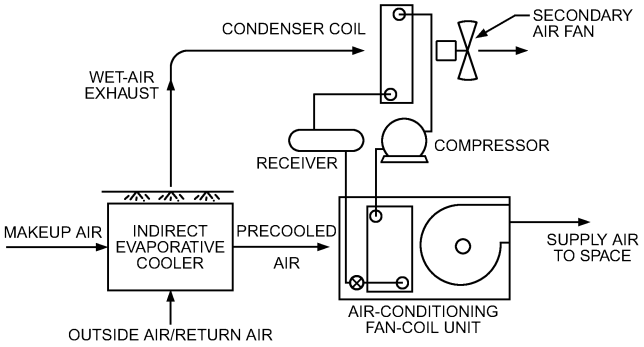


Fig. 4 Indirect Evaporative Cooler Used as Precooler

By placing the condenser coil in the wet-side air path leaving the heat exchanger, the mechanical cooling component's coefficient of performance (COP) significantly increases over that of an air-cooled condenser system with the coil in the ambient air. When building return air is used as the secondary airflow, compressor energy inputs are often reduced from 0.3 kW per kilowatt of cooling to 0.2 kW/kW or lower, because building return air from an air-conditioned building has wet-bulb conditions in the range of 15.5 to 18°C at a 24°C room dry-bulb temperature. Wet-side air leaving the heat exchanger is usually in the range of 21 to 24°C db, but at 80 to 90% rh, depending on the heat exchanger's wetting efficiency. Because refrigeration air-cooled condenser coils are unaffected by humidity, this cooler airstream may be used to reduce the refrigeration condensing temperature of the DX system, which increases compressor capacity and life by reducing vapor compression temperature lift.

Figure 5 shows how a heat-pipe, indirect evaporative cooling heat exchanger may be packaged with a DX-type refrigeration system, using building return air, to minimize cooling energy consumption for an all-outdoor-air design such as may be required for a laboratory or hospital application. The geometry of the heat pipe lends itself to the treatment of larger airflow quantities. The dimensions shown in Figure 5 are for a nominal 23.6 m^3/s supply air system with 775 kW of total load.

In addition, the heat pipe heat exchanger has the distinct advantage over other air-to-air heat exchangers of being able to isolate contaminated exhaust air from clean makeup air with a double-walled partition at the center bulkhead separating the two airflows. For laboratory applications, supply air fans should be positioned to blow through the heat pipe, to allow the heat pipe indirect evaporative cooler to remove some of the supply fan heat from the air before its delivery to the DX evaporator coil.

As an example, Figure 5 shows state-point conditions at each stage of the process, assuming a required 13°C db supply air temperature and an outdoor air (OA) inlet condition at summer design of 39°C db and 21.1°C wb. The indirect-cooling heat pipe reduces the outdoor air to 23°C db, 15.8°C wb where it enters the direct-expansion (DX) cooling evaporator coil. The refrigeration coil sensibly cools the outdoor air to 13°C db and 12°C wb, which for 23.6 m^3/s would require 306 kW. All values are for a sea-level application.

On the return-air side of the heat pipe heat exchanger, the condition entering the heat pipe is 24°C db and 17°C wb. After passing through the wet side of the heat pipe, the return air enters the condenser coil at 22°C and 88% rh. The heat of compression (387 kW) is rejected to the 21.2 m^3/s airflow and exhausted at a condition of 37°C db, 24.7°C wb.

A mist eliminator downstream of the sprayed heat pipe keeps water droplets from carrying over to wet the refrigerant-condensing coil. This cool, humid exhaust air provides an excellent source into

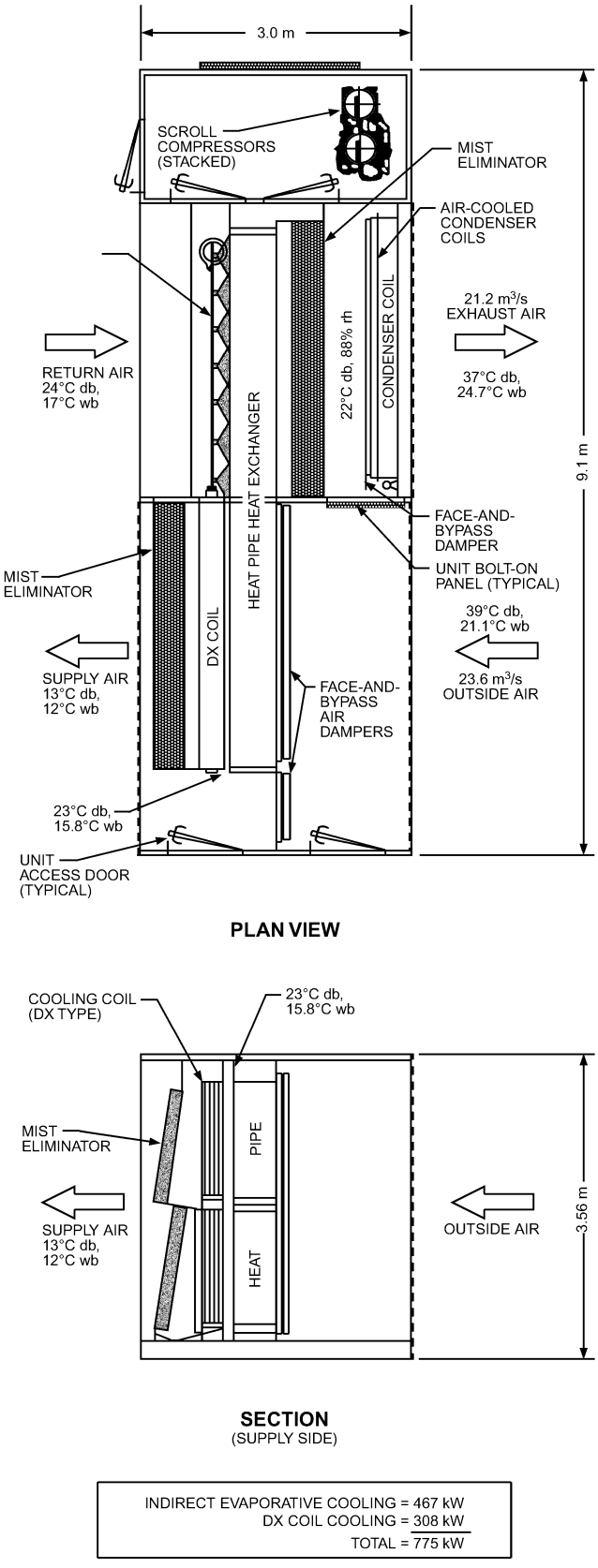


Fig. 5 Heat Pipe Indirect Evaporative Cooling (IEC) Heat Exchanger Packaged with DX System

which the condenser coil may reject heat. Condenser coil face-and-bypass dampers control condensing head pressure within an acceptable range. During winter, when the heat exchanger recovers heat and the sprays are off, these dampers are both open to minimize the condenser coil static pressure penalty.

Many applications below 700 kW use roof-mounted, air-cooled condensers. The 23.6 m^3/s IEC unit in Figure 5 delivers 467 kW of sensible cooling to the outdoor air with an energy consumption of 0.06 kW per kilowatt of cooling and an EER of 60. The evaporatively cooled refrigeration provides the remaining 308 kW of cooling required on the hottest day of the summer. To deliver 13°C db and 12°C wb to the building, the energy consumed for the refrigeration component is 0.2 kW/kW, with an EER of 17.1. A conventional air-cooled condensing unit on the roof in 38°C ambient temperatures typically requires 0.3 kW/kW to deliver 775 kW of total load, or a total peak demand of 242 kW. By comparison, on the hottest day of the year, the heat-pipe IEC and evaporatively cooled refrigeration design only consume 87.55 kW for a combined EER of 30.2. The total peak demand reduction for an all-outdoor-air design in this example is 154.45 kW.

Because the wet side of the heat pipe has a surface temperature of 21 to 24°C when subjected to 38°C ambient air temperatures, scale and fouling of the exhaust-side surface progress very slowly. Systems of this type have been in successful service for over 25 years at various sites in North America.

For sprayed heat-pipe applications, a one-piece heat pipe is recommended. All-aluminum heat pipes are available constructed of series 3003 alloy. The fin surface is extruded directly from the heat tube wall. Corrosion-resistant coating for the wet-side surface may be necessary in some hard-water applications. Wastewater bleed rates should be field set based on the water chemistry analysis. Water consumption in the range of 0.13 to 0.2 L/s per 10 m^3/s of supply air is typical, for both evaporation and bleed, for an IEC system.

Chapter 53 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* includes sample evaporative cooling calculations. Manufacturers' data should be followed to select equipment for cooling performance, pressure drop, and space requirements.

Manufacturers' ratings require careful interpretation. The basis of ratings should be specified because, for the same equipment, performance is affected by changes in primary and secondary air velocities and mass flow ratios, wet-bulb temperature, altitude, and other factors.

Typically, air resistance on both primary and secondary sections ranges between 50 and 500 Pa. The ratio of secondary air to conditioned primary air may range from less than 0.3 to greater than 1.0, and has an effect on performance (Peterson 1993). Based on manufacturers' ratings, available equipment may be selected for indirect evaporative cooling effectiveness ranging from 40 to 80%.

Heat Recovery

Indirect evaporative cooling has been used in a number of heat recovery systems, including plate heat exchangers (Scofield and DesChamps 1984), heat pipe heat exchangers (Mathur 1991; Scofield 1986), rotary regenerative heat exchangers (Woolridge et al. 1976), and two-phase thermosiphon loop heat exchangers (Mathur 1990). Indirect evaporative cooling/heat recovery can be retrofitted on existing systems, lowering operational cost and peak demand (Goswami and Mathur 1993, 1995). For new installations, equipment can be downsized, lowering overall project and operational costs. Chapter 26 has more information on using indirect evaporative cooling with heat recovery.

Cooling Tower/Coil Systems

Combining a cooling tower or other evaporative water cooler with a water-to-air heat exchanger coil and water-circulating pump is another type of indirect evaporative cooling. Water flows from the cooling tower reservoir to the coil and returns to the tower's upper distribution header. Both open-water and closed-loop systems are used. Coils in open systems should be cleanable.

Recirculated water evaporatively cools to within a few degrees of the wet-bulb temperature as it flows over the wetted surfaces of the cooling tower. As cooled water flows through the tubes of the coil in the conditioned airstream, it picks up heat from the conditioned air. The water temperature increases, and the primary air is cooled without adding moisture to it. The water again cools as it recirculates through the cooling tower. A float valve controls the fresh-water makeup, which replaces evaporated water. Bleedoff prevents excessive concentration of minerals in recirculated water.

One advantage of a cooling tower, especially for retrofits, large built-up systems, and dispersed air handlers, is that it may be remotely located from the cooling coil. In addition, the tower is more accessible for maintenance. Overall WBDE may range between 55% and 75% or higher. If return air goes to the cooling tower of an indirect cooling system before discharging outdoors, the cooling tower should be specifically designed for this purpose. These coolers wet a medium that has a high ratio of wetted surface area per unit of medium volume. Performance depends on depth of the medium, air velocity over the medium surface, water flow to airflow ratio, wet-bulb temperature, and water-cooling range. Because of the close approach of the water temperature to the wet-bulb temperature, overall effectiveness may be higher than that of a conventional cooling tower.

Other Indirect Evaporative Cooling Equipment

Other combinations of evaporative coolers and heat exchangers can accomplish indirect evaporative cooling. Heat pipes and rotary heat wheels, two-phase thermosiphon coil loops, plate and pleated media, and shell-and-tube heat exchangers have all been used. If the conditioned (primary) air and the exhaust or outdoor (secondary) airstream are side by side, a heat pipe or heat wheel can transfer heat from the warmer air to the cooler air. Evaporative cooling of the secondary airstream by spraying water directly on the surfaces of the heat exchanger (excluding heat wheels) or by a direct evaporative cooler upstream of the heat exchanger may cool the primary air indirectly by transferring heat from it to the secondary air.

3. INDIRECT/DIRECT COMBINATIONS

In a two-stage indirect/direct evaporative cooler, a first-stage indirect evaporative cooler lowers both the dry- and wet-bulb temperature of the incoming air. After leaving the indirect stage, the supply air passes through a second-stage direct evaporative cooler; Figure 6 shows the process on a psychrometric chart. First-stage cooling follows a line of constant humidity ratio because no moisture is added to the primary airstream. The second stage follows the wet-bulb line at the condition of the air leaving the first stage.

The indirect evaporative cooler may be any of the types described previously. Figure 7 shows a cooler using a rotary heat wheel or heat pipe. The secondary air may be exhaust air from the conditioned space or outdoor air. When secondary air passes through the direct evaporative cooler, evaporative cooling lowers the dry-bulb temperature. As this air passes through the heat wheel, the mass of the medium cools to a temperature approaching the wet-bulb temperature of the secondary air. The heat wheel rotates (note, however, that a heat pipe has no moving parts) so that its cooled mass enters the primary air and, in turn, sensibly cools the primary (supply) air. After the heat wheel or pipe, a direct evaporative cooler further reduces the dry-bulb temperature of the primary air. This method can lower the supply air dry-bulb temperature by 6 K or more below the initial secondary air wet-bulb temperature.

In areas where the 0.4% mean coincident wet-bulb design temperature is 19°C or lower, average annual cooling power consumption of indirect/direct systems may be as low as 0.06 kW/kW. When the 0.4% mean coincident wet-bulb temperature is as high as 23°C, indirect/direct cooling can have an average annual cooling power consumption as low as 0.23 kW/kW. By comparison, the typical refrigeration system with an air-cooled condenser may have average annual power consumption greater than 0.28 kW/kW.

In dry environments, indirect/direct evaporative cooling usually supplies 100% outdoor air to the conditioned spaces of a building. In these once-through applications, space latent loads and return air sensible loads are exhausted from the building rather than returned to the conditioning equipment. Consequently, the cooling capacity required from these systems may be less than from a conventional refrigerated cooling system. Design features to consider in systems such as the one in Figure 7 include air filters on the entering side of each heat wheel or pipe.

In areas with a high wet-bulb design temperature or where the design requires a supply air temperature lower than that attainable using indirect/direct evaporative cooling, a third cooling stage may be required. This stage may be a direct-expansion refrigeration unit or a chilled-water coil located either upstream or downstream from the direct evaporative cooling stage, but always downstream from the indirect evaporative stage. Refrigerated cooling occurs only when evaporative stages cannot achieve the required supply air temperature. Figure 8 shows a three-stage configuration (indirect/direct, with optional third-stage refrigerated cooling). The third-stage refrigerated cooling coil is downstream from the direct evaporative cooler. This requires careful selection and adjustment of controls to avoid removing more moisture by the refrigerated cooling coil than can be added by the direct evaporative cooling components. Analysis of static pressure drop through all components during design is critical to maintain optimum system total pressure loss and overall system efficiency. Note the face-and-bypass damper in Figure 8 around the indirect evaporative cooler. The bypass damper allows uncontaminated building return air to be recirculated in winter and mixed with outdoor air, as occurs in an air economizer. The fan parasitic losses of the indirect cooler heat exchanger may thus be reduced during cold weather for variable-air-volume air handlers.

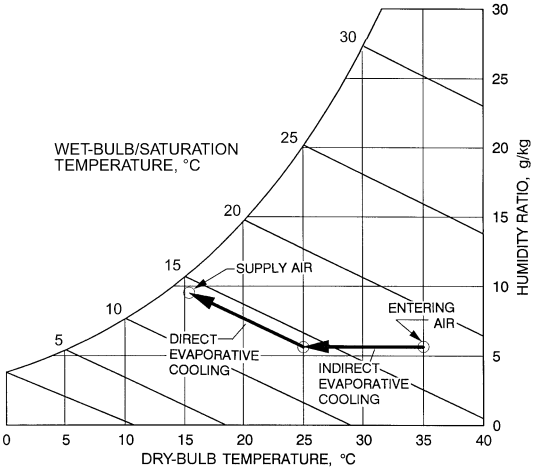


Fig. 6 Combination Indirect/Direct Evaporative Cooling Process

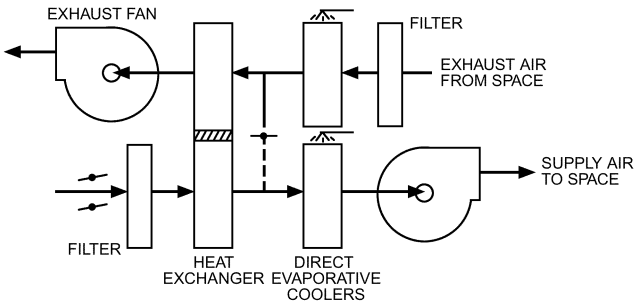


Fig. 7 Indirect/Direct Evaporative Cooler with Heat Exchanger (Rotary Heat Wheel or Heat Pipe)

The designer should consider using building exhaust and/or outdoor air as secondary air (whichever has the lower wet-bulb temperature) for indirect evaporative cooling. If possible, the indirect evaporative cooler should be designed to use both outdoor air and building exhaust as the secondary airstream; whichever source has the lower wet-bulb temperature should be used. Dampers and an enthalpy sensor are used to control this process. If the latent load in the space is significant, the wet-bulb temperature of the building exhaust air in cooling mode may be higher than that of the outdoor air. In this case, outdoor air may be used more effectively as secondary air to the indirect evaporative cooling stage.

Custom indirect/direct and three-stage configurations are available to allow many choices for location of the return, exhaust, and outdoor air; mixing of airstreams; bypass of components; or variable-volume control. Controllable elements include

- Modulating outdoor air and return air mixing dampers
- Secondary air fans and recirculating pumps of an indirect evaporative stage
- Recirculating pumps of a direct evaporative cooling stage
- Face-and-bypass dampers for the direct or indirect evaporative stage
- Chilled-water or refrigerant flow for a refrigerated stage
- System or individual terminal volume with variable-volume terminals, adjustable pitch fans, or variable-speed fans

For sequential control in indirect/direct evaporative cooling, the indirect evaporative cooler is energized for first-stage cooling, the direct evaporative cooler for second-stage cooling, and the refrigeration coil for third-stage cooling. In some applications, reversing the sequence of the direct and indirect evaporative coolers may reduce the first-stage power requirement. These systems are typically unfamiliar to most operations and maintenance staff, so special training may be needed.

Precooling and Makeup Air Pretreatment

Evaporative cooling may be used to increase capacity and reduce the electrical demand of a mechanical refrigeration system. Both the condenser and makeup air may be evaporatively cooled by direct and/or indirect means.

The condenser may have its cooling enhanced by adding a direct evaporative cooler in front of the condenser coil. The direct evapo-

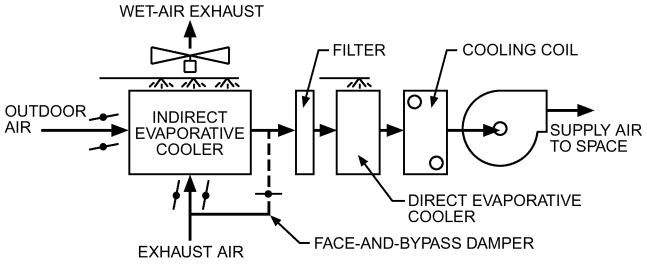


Fig. 8 Three-Stage Indirect/Direct Evaporative Cooler

rative cooler must add very little resistance to the airflow to the condenser, and face velocities must be well below velocities that would entrain liquid and carry it to the condenser. Condenser cooler maintenance should be infrequent and easy to perform. A well-designed direct evaporative cooler can reduce electrical demand and energy consumption of refrigeration units by10 to 30%.

Makeup air cooling with an indirect/direct evaporative unit can be applied both to standard packaged units and to large built-up systems. Either outdoor air or building exhaust air (whichever has the lower wet-bulb temperature) can be used as the secondary air source. Outdoor air is generally easier to cool, and in some cases is the only option because the building exhaust is hazardous (e.g., from a laboratory) or remote from the makeup air inlet. If building exhaust air can be used as the secondary air source, it has the potential of heat recovery during cold weather. In general, outdoor air cooling has higher energy savings and lower electrical demand savings than return air cooling. These systems can significantly reduce the outdoor air load and should be analyzed using a psychrometric process for the region and climate being considered.

4. AIR WASHERS

Spray Air Washers

Spray air washers consist of a chamber or casing containing spray nozzles, a tank for collecting spray water as it falls, and an eliminator section for removing entrained drops of water from the air. A pump recirculates water at a rate higher than the evaporation rate. Intimate contact between the spray water and the air causes heat and mass transfer between the air and water (Figure 9). Air washers are commonly available from 1 to 120 m^3/s capacity, but specially constructed washers can be made in any size. No standards exist; each manufacturer publishes tables giving physical data and ratings for specific products. Therefore, air velocity, water spray density, spray pressure, and other design factors must be considered for each application.

The simplest design has a single bank of spray nozzles with a casing that is usually 1.2 to 2.1 m long. This type of washer is applied primarily as an evaporative cooler or humidifier. It is sometimes used as an air cleaner when the dust is wettable, although its air-cleaning efficiency is relatively low. Two or more spray banks are generally used when a very high degree of saturation is necessary and for cooling and dehumidification applications that require chilled water. Two-stage washers are used for dehumidification when the quantity of chilled water is limited or when the water temperature is above that required for the single-stage design. Arranging the two stages for water counterflow allows use of a small quantity of water with a greater water temperature rise.

Lengths of washers vary considerably. Spray banks are spaced from 0.8 to 1.4 m apart; the first and last banks of sprays are located about 0.3 to 0.5 m from the entering or leaving end of the washer. In addition, air washers may be furnished with heating or cooling coils in the washer chamber, which may affect the overall length of the washer.

Some water (even very soft water) should always be bled off (continually and/or by using a dump or purge cycle) to prevent mineral build-up and to retard microbial growth. When the unit is shut down, all water should drain from the pipes. Low spots and dead ends must be avoided. Because an air washer is a direct-contact heat exchanger, water treatment is critical for proper operation as well as good hygiene. Algae and bacteria can be controlled by a chemical or ozone treatment program and/or regularly scheduled mechanical cleaning. Make sure that any chemicals used are compatible with all components in the air washer.

Resistance to airflow through an air washer varies with the type and number of baffles, eliminators, and wetted surfaces; the number of spray banks and their direction and air velocity; the size and type of other components, such as cooling and heating coils; and other factors, such as air density. Pressure drop may be as low as 60 Pa or as high as 250 Pa. The manufacturer should be consulted regarding the resistance of any particular washer design combination.

The casing and tank may be constructed of various materials. One or more doors are commonly provided for inspection and access. An air lock must be provided if the unit is to be entered while it is running. The tank is normally at least 400 mm high with a 350 mm water level; it may extend beyond the casing on the inlet end to make the suction strainer more accessible. The tank may be partitioned by a weir (usually in the entering end) to allow recirculation of spray water for control purposes in dehumidification work. The excess then returns over the weir to the central water-chilling machine.

Eliminators consist of a series of vertical plates that are spaced about 20 to 50 mm on centers at the exit of the washer. The plates are formed with numerous bends to deflect air and obtain impingement on the wetted surfaces. Hooks on the edge of the plates improve moisture elimination. Perforated plates may be installed on the inlet end of the washer to obtain more uniform air distribution through the spray chamber. Louvers, which prevent backlash of spray water, may also be installed for this purpose.

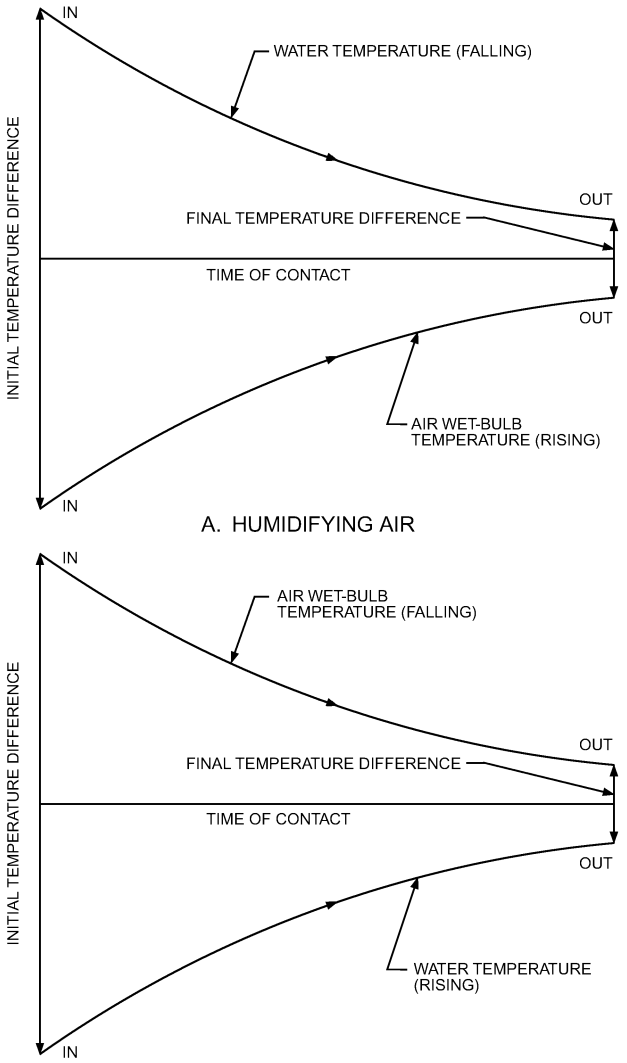


Fig. 9 Interaction of Air and Water in Air Washer Heat Exchanger

High-Velocity Spray-Type Air Washers

High-velocity air washers generally operate at air velocities in the range of 6 to 9 m/s. Some have been applied as high as 12 m/s, but 6 to 8 m/s is the most accepted range. The reduced cross-sectional area of high-velocity air washers allows them to be used in smaller equipment than those operating with lower air velocities. High capacities per unit of space available from high-velocity spray devices allow practical prefabrication of central station units in either completely assembled and transportable form or, for large-capacity units, easily handled modules. Manufacturers supply units with capacities of up to 70 m^3/s shipped in one piece, including spray system, eliminators, pump, fan, dampers, filters, and other functional components. Such units are self-housed, prewired, prepiped, and ready for hoisting into place.

The number and arrangement of nozzles vary with different capacities and manufacturers. Adequate values of saturation effectiveness and heat transfer effectiveness are achieved by using higher spray density.

Eliminator blades come in varying shapes, but most are a series of aerodynamically clean, sinusoidal shapes. Collected moisture flows down grooves or hooks designed into their profiles, then drains into the storage tank. Washers may be built with shallow drain pans and connected to a central storage tank. High-velocity washers are rectangular in cross section and, except for the eliminators, are similar in appearance and construction to conventional lower-velocity types. Pressure loss is in the range of 120 to 380 Pa. These washers are available either as freestanding separate devices for incorporation into field-built central stations or in complete preassembled central station packages from the factory.

5. HUMIDIFICATION/DEHUMIDIFICATION

Humidification with Air Washers and Rigid Media

Air can be humidified with air washers and rigid media by (1) using recirculated water without prior heating of the air, (2) preheating the air and humidifying it with recirculated water, or (3) preheating recirculated water. Precise humidity control may be achieved by arranging rigid media in one or more banks in depth, height, or width, or by providing a controlled bypass. Each bank is activated independently of the others to achieve the desired humidity. In any evaporative humidification application, air should not be allowed to enter the process with a wet-bulb temperature of less than 4°C, or the water may freeze.

Recirculation Without Preheating. Except for the small amount of energy added by the recirculating pump and the small amount of heat leakage into or from the apparatus (including the pump and its connecting piping), the process is adiabatic. Water temperature in the collection basin closely approaches the thermodynamic wet-bulb temperature of the entering air, but it cannot be brought to complete saturation. The psychrometric state point of the leaving air is on the constant thermodynamic wet-bulb temperature line with its end state determined by the saturation effectiveness of the device. Leaving humidity conditions may be controlled using the saturation effectiveness of the process by bypassing air around the evaporative process.

Preheating Air. Preheating air entering an evaporative humidifier increases both the dry- and wet-bulb temperatures and lowers the relative humidity, but it does not alter the air's humidity ratio (mass ratio of water vapor to dry air). As a result, preheating allows more water to be absorbed per unit mass of dry air passing through the process at the same saturation effectiveness. Control is achieved by varying the amount of air preheating at a constant saturation effectiveness. Control precision is a direct function of saturation effectiveness, and a high degree of correlation may be achieved between leaving air and leaving dew-point temperatures when high-saturation-effectiveness devices are used.

Heated Recirculated Water. If heat is added to the water, the process state point of the mixture moves toward the temperature of the heated water (Figure 9A). Elevating the water temperature makes it possible to raise the air dry- and wet-bulb temperatures above the dry-bulb temperature of the entering air with the leaving air becoming fully saturated. Relative humidity of the leaving air can be controlled by (1) bypassing some of the air around the media banks and remixing the two airstreams downstream by using dampers or (2) by automatically reducing the number of operating media banks through pump staging or by operating valves in the different distribution branches.

The following table shows the saturation or humidifying effectiveness of a spray air washer for various spray arrangements. The degree of saturation depends on the extent of contact between air and water. Other conditions being equal, a low-velocity airflow is conducive to higher humidifying effectiveness.

Bank Arrangement	Length, m	Effectiveness, %
1 downstream	1.2	50 to 60
	1.8	60 to 75
1 upstream	1.8	65 to 80
2 downstream	2.4 to 3	80 to 90
2 opposing	2.4 to 3	85 to 95
2 upstream	2.4 to 3	90 to 98

Dehumidification with Air Washers and Rigid Media

Air washers and rigid-media direct evaporative coolers may also be used to cool and dehumidify air. Compared to a typical chilled-water or direct-expansion (DX) cooling coil, direct-contact dehumidification can significantly reduce fan power requirements, static pressure losses, and energy consumption (El-Morsi et al. 2003). As shown in Figure 9B, heat and moisture removed from the air raise the water temperature. If the entering water temperature is below the entering air dew point, both the dry- and wet-bulb temperatures of the air are reduced, resulting in cooling and dehumidification. The vapor pressure difference between the entering air and water cools the air. Moisture is transferred from the air to the water, and condensation occurs. Air leaving an evaporative dehumidifier is typically saturated, usually with less than 0.5 K difference between leaving dry- and wet-bulb temperatures.

The difference between the leaving air and water temperatures depends on the difference between entering dry- and wet-bulb temperatures and the process effectiveness, which may be affected by factors such as length and height of the spray chamber, air velocity, quantity of water flow, and spray pattern. Final water conditions are typically 0.5 to 1 K below the leaving air temperature, depending on the saturation effectiveness of the device used.

The common design value for the water temperature rise is usually between 3 and 7 K for refrigerant-chilled water and normal air-conditioning applications, although higher rises are possible and have been used successfully. A smaller rise may be considered when water is chilled by mechanical refrigeration. If warmer water is used, less mechanical refrigeration is required; however, a larger quantity of chilled water is needed to do the same amount of sensible cooling. An economic analysis may be required to determine the best alternative. For humidifiers receiving water from a thermal storage or other low-temperature system, a design with a high temperature rise and minimum water flow may be desirable.

Performance Factors. An evaporative dehumidifier has a performance factor of 1.0 if it can cool and dehumidify the entering air to a wet-bulb temperature equal to the leaving water temperature. This represents a theoretical maximum value that is thermodynamically impossible to achieve. Performance is maximized when both water surface area and air/water contact is maximized. The actual performance factor F_p of any evaporative dehumidifier is less than

one and is calculated by dividing the actual air enthalpy change by the theoretical maximum air enthalpy change where

$$F_p = \frac{h_1 - h_2}{h_1 - h_3} \quad (3)$$

where

h_1 = enthalpy at wet-bulb temperature of entering air, kJ/kg
h_2 = enthalpy at wet-bulb temperature of leaving air at actual condition, kJ/kg
h_3 = enthalpy of air at wet-bulb temperature leaving a dehumidifier with $F_p = 1.0$, kJ/kg

Air Cleaning

Air washers and rigid-media direct evaporative cooling equipment can remove particulate and gaseous contaminants with varying degrees of effectiveness through wet scrubbing (which is discussed in Chapter 30). Particle removal efficiencies of rigid media and air washers differ due to differences in equipment construction and principles of operation. Removal also depends largely on the size, density, wettability, and/or solubility of the contaminants to be removed. Large, wettable particles are the easiest to remove. The primary mechanism of separation is by impingement of particles on a wetted surface, which includes eliminator plates in air washers and corrugations of wetted rigid media. Spraying is relatively ineffective in removing most atmospheric dusts. Because the force of impact increases with the size of the solid, the impact (together with the adhesive quality of the wetted surface) determines the device's usefulness as a dust remover.

In practice, air-cleaning results of air washers and rigid-media direct-evaporative coolers are typical of comparable impingement filters. Air washers are of little use in removing soot particles because of the lack of adhesion to a greasy surface. They are also relatively ineffective in removing smoke because the particles are too small (less than 1 μm) to impact and be retained on the wet surfaces.

Despite their air-cleaning performance, rigid media should not be used for primary filtering. When a rigid-media cooler is placed in an unfiltered airstream, it can quickly become fouled with airborne dust and fibrous debris. When wet, debris can collect in the recirculation basin and in the media, feeding bacterial growth. Bacteria in the air can propagate in waste materials and debris and cause microbial slimes. Filtering entering air is the most effective way to keep debris from accumulating in rigid media. With high-efficiency filters upstream from the cells, most microbial agents and nutrients can be removed from the airstream. Replace rigid media if the corrugations are filled with contaminants when they are dry.

6. SOUND ATTENUATION

Although evaporative cooling media pads are not intended for use as a sound attenuator in air-conditioning systems, tests by Munters Corp. (2002) have shown significant insertion loss, especially in the higher-frequency octave-band center frequency range of 4000 and 8000 Hz. This is of special interest in noise-sensitive applications such as gas turbine inlet cooling systems. Different depths of evaporative cooling media were tested at different face velocities at both wet- and dry-pad conditions. Net insertion loss in the third band (250 Hz) ranged between 2 and 3 dB for both 300 and 400 mm deep media at measured face velocities of 2 to 3.8 m/s.

7. MAINTENANCE AND WATER TREATMENT

Regular inspection and maintenance of evaporative coolers, air washers, and ancillary equipment ensures proper service and efficiency. Manufacturers' recommendations for maintenance and operation should be followed to help ensure safe, efficient operation. Water lines, water distribution troughs or sumps, pumps, and pump filters must be clean and free of dirt, scale, and debris. They must be constructed so that they can be easily flushed and cleaned. Inadequate water flow causes dry areas on the evaporative media, which reduces the saturation effectiveness and useful life. Motors and bearings should be lubricated and fan drives checked periodically.

Water and air filters should be cleaned or replaced as required. The sump water level must be kept below the bottom of the pads, yet high enough to prevent air from short-circuiting below the pads. Bleeding off some water is the most practical means to minimize scale accumulation. The bleed rate should be 5 to 100% of the evaporation rate, depending on water hardness and airborne contaminant level. The water circulation pump should be used to bleed off water (suction by a draw-through fan will otherwise prevent the bleed system from operating effectively). A flush-out cycle, which runs fresh water through the pad every 24 h when the fan is off, may also be used. This water should run for 10 min for every metre of media height.

Steam or high-temperature water should not be used to clean either heat pipes or thermosiphon loop air-to-air heat exchangers. High pressure generated by the refrigerant charge inside the individual tubes can severely damage the heat pipes and thermosiphons.

Regular inspections should be made to ensure that the bleed rate is adequate and is maintained. Some manufacturers provide a purge cycle in which the entire sump is purged of water and accumulated debris. This cycle helps maintain a cleaner system and may actually save water compared to a standard bleed system. Purge frequency depends on water quality as well as the amount and type of external contaminants. Sumps should have drain couplings on the bottom rather than on the side, to drain the sump completely. Additionally, the sump bottom should slope toward the drain (approximately 20 mm per metre of sump length) to facilitate complete draining.

Water Treatment. An effective water treatment and biocide program for cooling towers is not necessarily good practice for evaporative coolers. Evaporative coolers and cooling towers differ significantly: evaporative coolers are directly connected with the supply airstream, whereas cooling towers only indirectly affect the supply air. The effect a biocide may have on evaporative media (both direct and indirect systems) as well as the potential for offensive and/or harmful residual off-gassing must be considered.

Pretreatment of a water supply with chemicals intended to hold dissolved material in suspension is best prescribed by a water treatment specialist. Water treated by a zeolite ion exchange softener should not be used because the zeolite exchange of calcium for sodium results in a soft, voluminous scale that may cause dust problems downstream. Any chemical agents used should not promote microbial growth or harm the cabinet, media, or heat exchanger materials. This topic is discussed in more detail in Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*. Consider the following factors for water treatment:

- Use caution when using very pure water from reverse osmosis or deionization in media-based evaporative coolers. This water does not wet random media well, and it can deteriorate many types of media because of its corrosive nature. The same problem can occur in a once-through water distribution system if the water is very pure.
- Periodically check for algae, slime, and bacterial growth. If required, add a biocide registered for use in evaporative coolers by an appropriate agency, such as the U.S Environmental Protection Agency (EPA).

Ozone-generation systems have been used as an alternative to standard chemical biocide water treatments. Ozone can be produced on site (eliminating chemical storage) and injected into the water circulation system. It is a fast-acting oxidizer that rapidly breaks down to nontoxic compounds. In low concentrations, ozone is benign to humans and to the materials used in evaporative coolers.

Algae can be minimized by reducing the media and sump exposure to nutrient and light sources (by using hoods, louvers, and prefilters), by keeping the bottom of the media out of standing water in the sump, and by allowing the media to completely dry out every 24 h.

Scale. Units that have heat exchangers with a totally wetted surface and materials that are not harmed by chemicals can be descaled periodically with a commercial descaling agent and then flushed out. Mineral scale deposits on a wetted indirect evaporative heat exchanger are usually soft and allow wetting through to and evaporation at the surface of the heat exchanger. Excess scale thickness reduces heat transfer and should be removed.

Nonchemical Water Treatment. Makeup and recirculation water furnished to a rigid-media-pad, direct evaporative cooler should be treated to reduce the risk of airborne microbial or particulate contamination of the building supply air. See Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for more information on nonchemical water treatment.

Air Washers. The air washer spray system requires the most attention. Partially clogged nozzles are indicated by a rise in spray pressure; a fall in pressure is symptomatic of eroded orifices. Strainers can minimize this problem. Continuous operation requires either a bypass around pipeline strainers or duplex strainers. Air washer tanks should be drained and dirt deposits removed regularly. Eliminators and baffles should be periodically inspected and repainted to prevent corrosion damage.

Freeze Protection. In colder climates, evaporative coolers must be protected from freezing. This is usually done seasonally by simply draining the cooler and the water supply line with solenoid valves. Often, an outdoor air temperature sensor initiates this action. It is important that drain solenoid valves be of zero-differential design. If a heat exchanger coil is used, the tubes must be horizontal so they will drain to the lowest part of their manifold.

Legionnaires' Disease

Legionnaires' disease is contracted by inhaling into the lower respiratory system an aerosol (1 to 5 μm in diameter) laden with sufficient *Legionella pneumophila* bacteria. Evaporative coolers do not provide suitable growth conditions for the bacteria and generally do not release an aerosol. A good maintenance program eliminates potential microbial problems and reduces the concern for disease transmittal (ASHRAE 2000, 2015; Puckorius et al. 1995). There have been no known cases of Legionnaires' disease with air washers or wetted-media evaporative coolers/humidifiers, and there is no positive association of Legionnaires' disease with indirect evaporative coolers (ASHRAE *Guideline* 12).

The following precautions and maintenance procedures for water systems also improve cooler performance, reduce microbial growth and musty odors, and prolong equipment life:

- Run fans after turning off water until the media completely dries.
- Thoroughly clean and flush the entire cooling water loop regularly (minimum monthly). Disinfect before and after cleaning.
- Avoid dead-end piping, low spots, and other areas in the water distribution system where water may stagnate during shutdown.
- Obtain and maintain the best available mist elimination technology, especially when using misters and air washers.
- Do not locate the evaporative cooler inlet near a cooling tower outlet.
- Maintain system bleedoff and/or purge consistent with makeup water quality.
- Maintain system cleanliness. Deposits from calcium carbonate, minerals, and nutrients may contribute to growth of molds, slime, and other microbes annoying to building occupants.
- Develop a maintenance checklist, and follow it on a regular basis.
- Consult the equipment or media manufacturer for more detailed assistance in water system maintenance and treatment.

ASHRAE *Standard* 188 gives detailed guidance on risk management for building water systems.

8. VAV ADIABATIC HUMIDIFICATION WITH A HEAT RECOVERY ECONOMIZER

Health benefits of humidification offered by a rigid-media adiabatic direct evaporative cooling (DEC) component are often overlooked in evaporative cooling design. During cold winter conditions, the outdoor air required to meet building code ventilation requirements will quickly drive indoor relative humidity below acceptable levels.

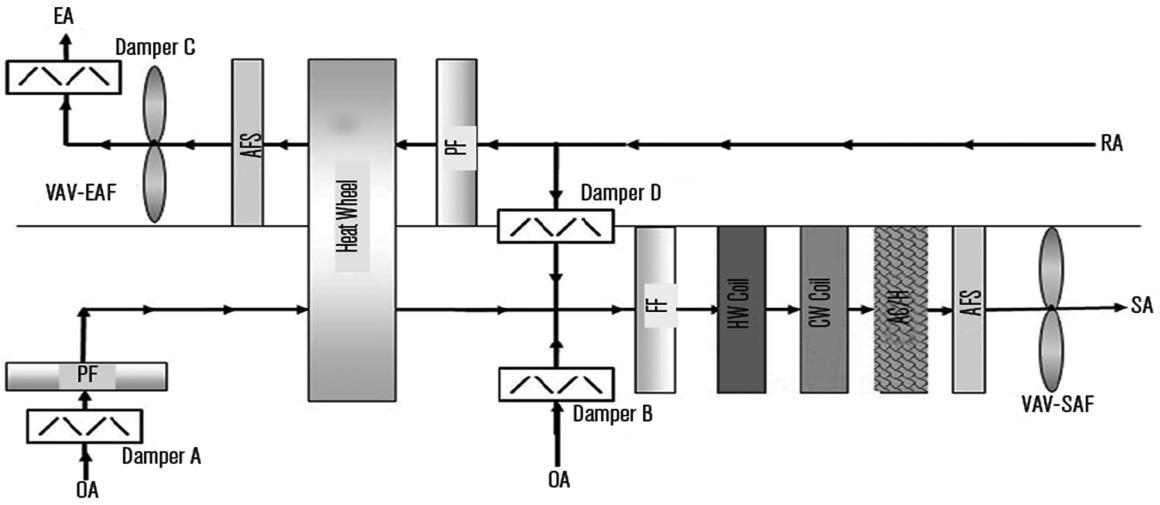
Figure 10 shows a schematic of an air-handling unit design that can provide hydration to the dry outdoor air in winter without greatly affecting the building owner's heating energy costs. The variable-air-volume (VAV) design concept (Scofield et al. 2015, 2016, 2020) uses a heat wheel air-to-air heat exchanger to recover heat from the building return air both to increase the fresh outdoor air fraction introduced to the building by the economizer dampers and to provide the heat necessary for the evaporation of water for humidification. Heat generated inside the building by people, lights, and plug load is recovered through the heat wheel and used to furnish 7.2°C dp supply air condition to the building. An airflow monitor added at damper A in Figure 10 will ensure that ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1's minimum outdoor air requirements for the building are met during cold weather VAV fan turndown.

Combining an all-outdoor-air VAV cooling design with an air-to-air heat exchanger saves significant heating and humidification energy cost and ensures that each climatic zone indoors received the code-required outdoor air (Taylor 2022). As mass flow through the air-to-air heat exchanger decreases, the heat exchanger becomes more effective. This is also true for the AC/H heat exchanger. When the dwell time in the heat exchanger goes up with VAV turndown, effectiveness (**wet-bulb depression efficiency [WBDE]**) increases and parasitic losses (e.g., static pressure) are reduced. The heat wheel effectiveness in Figure 10 increases from 75% to 87% when VAV turndown is reduced to 50% flow at winter design. The AC/H WBDE increases from 90% to 93%.

Chapter 10 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, section 3.6, provides details of how relative humidity plays an important role in controlling viruses (Taylor 2022). More outdoor air for the building during occupancy will produce better indoor air quality (IAQ) due to dilution of generated indoor air pollutants, including viruses.

Reducing a VAV building supply air temperature set point in cold weather reduces not only room air change rates (ACRs) but also supply and return fan energy costs for the owner (English et al. 2015). Code ventilation rates are often set at 25% of full flow or higher. Core zones require reheat coils to temper the supply air delivery temperature to the room, but if the VAV box is at its minimum flow setting, there would not be a heating penalty as the minimum code flow would match zone fresh air requirements. In California, for example, minimum VAV terminal flow settings by code are no less than 0.5 L/s per square metre of floor area in the zone being served. Reheat at the terminal box may be reduced if high induction ceiling diffusers are used to prevent heat stratification. Cold-air supply VAV systems use high-induction diffusers to prevent dumping of 7.2°C air into the indoor environment.

In cool ambient conditions during spring and fall, when allergens are rampant, the rigid-media pads of the AC/H act as an air scrubber, with 90% removal of pollens between 5 and 10 μm. This improves indoor air quality and reduces sinus and respiratory complaints (Periannan 2013).



Heat Wheel Air-to-air heat exchanger selected at 75% sensible effectiveness at full cfm flow. More humid climates with many ambient hours above a 55°F dew point (DP) would select an enthalpy heat wheel.

AC/H: An adiabatic cooler/humidifier selected at 90% or higher wet-bulb depression efficiency (WBDE) at full cfm flow. Delivery air dry bulb (DB) should be within 1°F of the delivery DP after adiabatic humidification when the VAV flow is 50% of full flow during cold ambient conditions. Hydration of cold-dry winter outdoor air is shown in *Figure 3*.

HW Coil: Hot water coil is the heating source for maintaining a minimum 45°F DP delivery condition to the building during extreme cold ambient conditions (see Climate Zone 1, *Table 1*).

CW Coil: Chilled water cooling coil to maintain a minimum 55°F delivered DB temperature to the building, after heat recovery of the outdoor air, at ambient conditions above 55°F DP and above 55°F wet bulb (WB).

Dampers A and B: These dampers modulate to deliver a 45°F DP to the building during ambient conditions in Climate Zone 2 (*Figure 3*) by mixing all outdoor air to produce a 45°F WB mixed-air condition delivered to the AC/H.

Dampers A and C: Shut-off dampers for night and weekend building shutdown.

Damper D: This damper is open during morning warm-up and prehumidification (*Figure 5*) of the building after night or weekend shutdown with Dampers A, B and C closed and the heat wheel off.

AFS: Airflow sensors for building pressurization and verification of ASHRAE Standard 62.1-2019.

PF and FF: Pre and final filters.

VAV-SAF and VAV-EAF: Variable air volume supply air fan and exhaust air fan for the air-handling unit (AHU).

Fig. 10 Airflow Through VAV Air-Handling Unit with Heat Recovery Economizer (HRE) and Adiabatic Direct Evaporative Cooler/Humidifier (AC/H) for Winter Hydration of Dry Outdoor Air
Supply air: 7.22° db and 7.22° dp. *Source*: Taylor et al. (2020).

9. COLD-CLIMATE, ALL-OUTDOOR-AIR, VAV WITH HUMIDIFICATION

Figure 11 shows a cold climate system for Seattle, WA, with a winter design of –5°C db and a –5.5°C wb. Assuming a 21°C building return air condition, the heat wheel (Figure 10) with 75% effectiveness at 100% VAV flow would require the air-to-air heat exchanger effectiveness to increase to 87% sensible at 50% supply fan flow to reach the 7.22°C wet-bulb line in Figure 11. The adiabatic humidifier then furnishes approximately 1.6 g of hydration to the 100% outdoor air. The resulting building supply air condition of 8.3°C db at 93% rh allows the space to be maintained at 21°C db and 40% rh, assuming a flat room load line.

Using local bin weather data, Table 1 shows, for 22 cold-climate northern U.S. cities, the approximate number of hours per year when both indoor humidification and a delivery dry-bulb condition ranging from 7.22°C to 12.8°C may be maintained *without* any expenditure of preheat energy (climate zones 2 and 3). The systems modeled would turn down to 50% minimum flow at winter design and would operate on a 24/7/365 duty cycle. The heat recovery effectiveness would vary from 75% at full flow up to 87% at minimum turndown flow with 10% less volume on the exhaust air side of the heat exchanger than on the makeup air side. On average, Table 1 shows that only 9.2% of the annual hours in climate zone 1 would require additional preheat energy to be added to heat-recovered energy. For buildings with daytime occupancy, many of these preheat conditions will have moved from climate zone 1 to climate zone 2, due to global climate change. Designers should check local TMY weather data to confirm this assumption.

Prehumidification and Morning Preheat

Because all buildings have a different capacitance for moisture storage (Lstiburek 2017), consider a morning prehumidification along with the customary building preheat control strategy after night and weekend building shutdowns. When buildings are shut down overnight, a faulty vapor barrier in the building envelope may allow moisture migration out of (or air infiltration into) the building, which will produce indoor environments well below the minimum recommended 40% rh.

In the system shown in Figure 10, this would involve opening recirculation dampers (D), and closing all outdoor and exhaust air dampers for hydration and heating of building air. The AC/H sump water recirculation pump would be on and the hot-water coil would be active to produce 12.8°C db supply air at the saturation curve (Figure 12). Assuming a room condition of 15.5°C db, the prehumidification process would add approximately 7 g of moisture per kilogramof dry air of hydration. The AC/H water recirculation pump would shut down when the building return air reached a dew point of 10°C, and the hot-water coil (H/C in Figure 10) would turn off after return air dry-bulb temperatures reached 21°C. Prehydration of the building helps maintain minimum indoor relative humid-

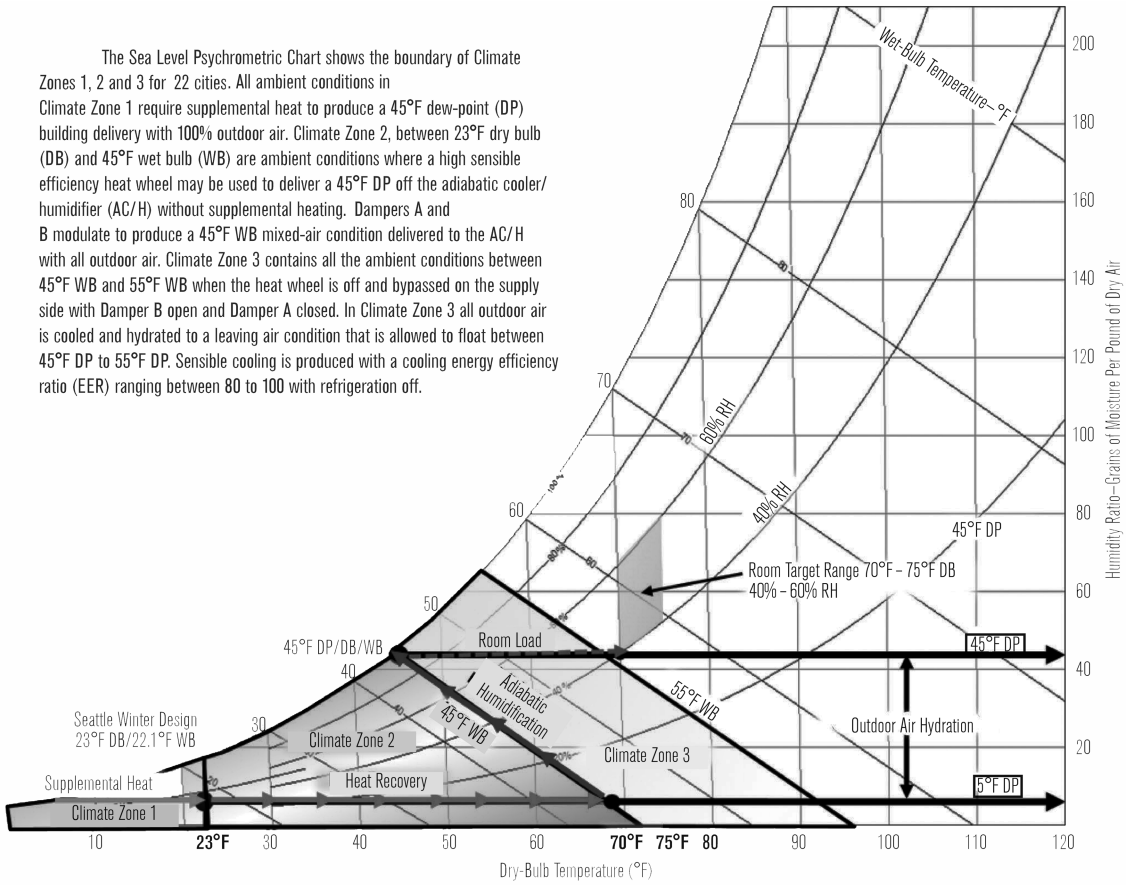


Fig. 11 Performance of Heat Recovery Economizer in Cold Climate

Air-to-air heat exchanger effectiveness is 70% and provides 13.3°C of outdoor air preheating using 21.1°C building exhaust air temperature. VAV supply fan operates at 25% of full-volume flow that provides minimum code-required outdoor air to building. Additional heating of 13.3°C is required to reach 7.2°C wb line for adiabatic humidification of dry outdoor air when adding 5.7 g of water per kilogram of dry air. *Source*: Taylor et al. (2020).

ity conditions during cold, dry daytime ambient conditions. Hygroscopic materials inside the building that store water vapor molecules in the vapor state will give moisture back into the air when room relative humidity drops, helping to maintain occupied building minimum relative humidity set points and providing a healthier indoor enviroment.

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Table 1 Bin Weather Data Distribution for 22 Northern U.S. Cities

		Climate Zone 1 Preheat for 100% OA		Climate Zone 2 Humidification Without Preheat with 100% OA and Heat Recovery		Climate Zone 3 Humidification of 100% OA without Preheat or Refrigeration, 7 to 13°C wb	
Location	**Elevation, m**	**Hours**	**%**	**Hours**	**%**	**Hours**	**%**
Boise, ID*	913	225	2.6	4214	48.1	3050	34.8
Chicago, IL	201	692	7.9	4272	48.8	1304	14.9
Des Moines, IA	286	903	10.3	3797	43.3	602	6.9
Boston, MA	41	619	7.1	3879	44.3	1419	16.2
Detroit, MI	178	709	8.1	3824	43.7	1287	14.7
Grand Rapids, MI	256	721	8.2	3851	44.0	1276	14.6
St. Paul, MN	254	1404	16.0	3236	36.9	1166	13.3
Billings, MT*	1087	822	9.4	4618	52.7	1968	22.5
Great Falls, MT*	1074	1016	11.6	4820	55.0	2224	25.4
Buffalo, NY	180	520	5.9	4050	46.2	1331	15.2
Bismarck, ND*	502	1772	20.2	3297	37.6	1822	20.8
Grand Forks, ND	278	2138	24.4	3159	36.1	1192	13.6
Cleveland, OH*	251	472	5.4	3386	38.7	1248	14.2
Harrisburg, PA	94	242	2.8	3642	41.6	1302	14.9
Pittsburgh, PA	347	491	5.6	3575	40.8	1365	15.6
Rapid City, SD*	999	961	11.0	4320	49.3	1989	22.7
Sioux Falls, SD*	432	1351	15.4	3280	37.4	1789	20.4
Seattle, WA*	14	18	0.2	3814	43.5	2747	31.4
Spokane, WA*	750	291	3.3	4718	53.9	3026	34.5
Madison, WI	262	1018	11.6	3612	41.2	1187	13.6
Casper, WY*	1627	827	9.4	4841	55.3	2539	29.0
Averages			**9.2**		**44.6**		**19.3**

Source: Ecodyne (1980).
*Western cities at high altitude.

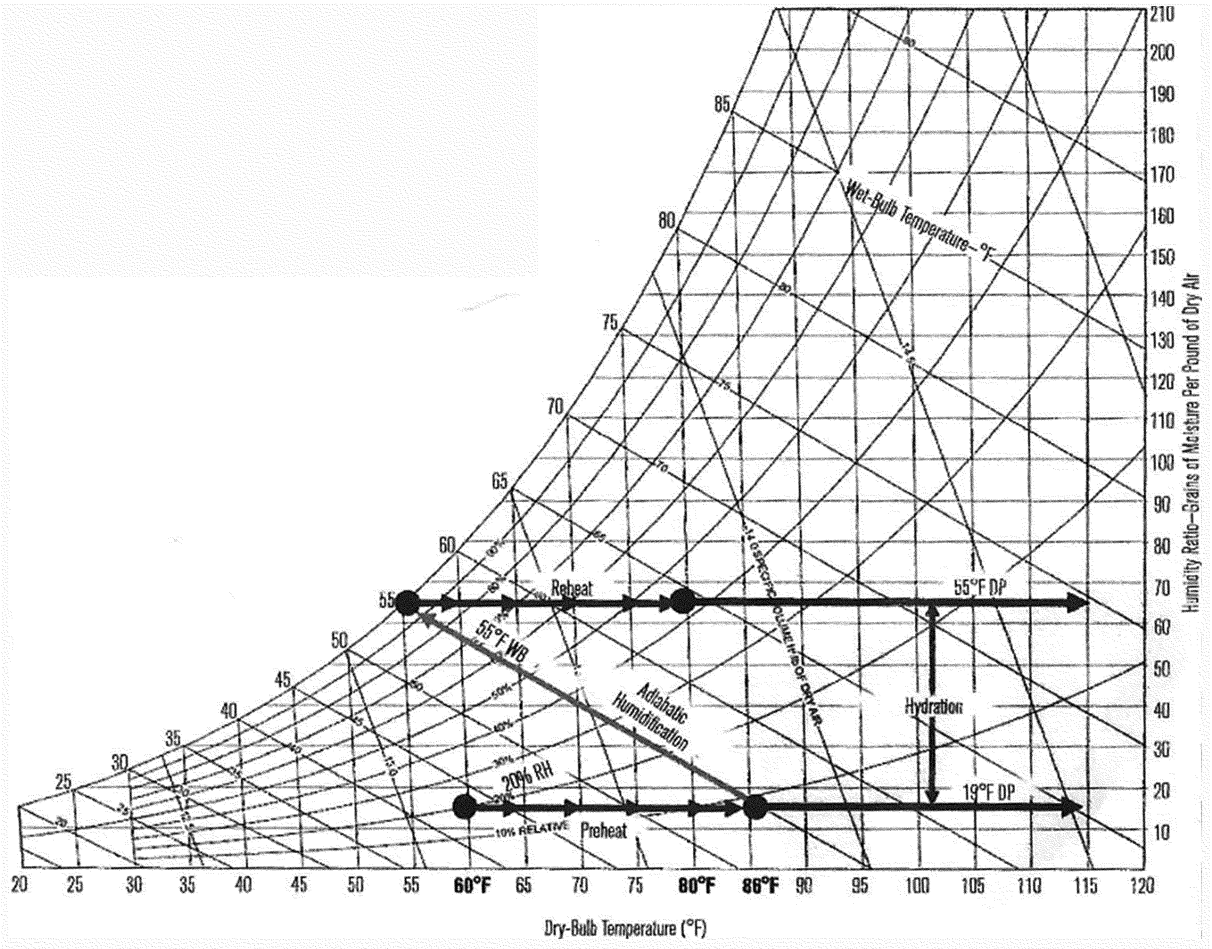

Fig. 12 Morning Warm-Up and Prehumidification Cycle Before Building Occupancy Using Building Return Air

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CHAPTER 42

LIQUID COOLERS

Types of Liquid Coolers 42.1
Heat Transfer 42.3
Pressure Drop 42.4
Vessel Design 42.5
Application Considerations 42.5

A LIQUID cooler (hereafter called a cooler) is a heat exchanger in which refrigerant is evaporated, thereby cooling a fluid (usually water or brine) circulating through the cooler. This chapter addresses the performance, design, and application of coolers.

1. TYPES OF LIQUID COOLERS

Various types of liquid coolers and their characteristics are listed in Table 1 and described in the following sections.

Direct-Expansion

Refrigerant evaporates inside the tubes of a direct-expansion cooler. These coolers are usually used with positive-displacement compressors, such as reciprocating, rotary, or rotary screw compressors, to cool various fluids, such as water, water/glycol mixtures, and brine. Common configurations include shell-and-tube, tube-in-tube, and brazed-plate.

Figure 1 shows a typical **shell-and-tube** cooler. A series of baffles channels the fluid throughout the shell side. The baffles create cross flow through the tube bundle and increase the velocity of the fluid, thereby increasing its heat transfer coefficient. The velocity of the fluid flowing perpendicular to the tubes should be at least 0.6 m/s, to clean the tubes and less than the velocity limit of the tube and baffle materials, to prevent erosion.

Refrigerant distribution is critical in direct-expansion coolers. If some tubes are fed more refrigerant than others, refrigerant may not fully evaporate in the overfed tubes, and liquid refrigerant may escape into the suction line. Because most direct-expansion coolers are controlled by an expansion valve that regulates suction superheat, the remaining tubes must produce a higher superheat to evaporate the liquid escaping into the suction line. This unbalance causes poor overall heat transfer. Uniform distribution is usually achieved by adding a distributor, which creates sufficient turbulence to promote a homogeneous mixture so that each tube gets the same mixture of liquid and vapor.

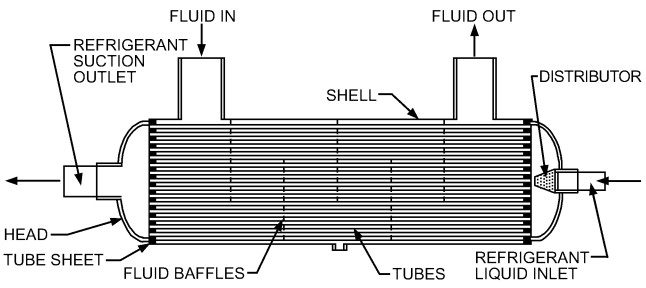

Fig. 1 Direct-Expansion Shell-and-Tube Cooler

The number of refrigerant passes is another important item in direct-expansion cooler performance. A single-pass cooler must completely evaporate the refrigerant before it reaches the end of the first pass; this requires relatively long tubes. A multiple-pass cooler is significantly shorter than a single-pass cooler, but must be properly designed to ensure proper refrigerant distribution after the first pass. Internally and externally enhanced tubes can also be used to reduce cooler size. Typical tube diameters are in the range of 8 to 16 mm.

A **tube-in-tube** cooler is similar to a shell-and-tube design, except that it consists of one or more pairs of coaxial tubes. The fluid usually flows inside the inner tube while the refrigerant flows in the annular space between the tubes. In this way, the fluid side can be mechanically cleaned if access to the header is provided.

Brazed- or **semiwelded-plate** coolers are constructed of plates brazed or laser-welded together to make an assembly of separate channels. Semiwelded designs have the refrigerant side welded and the fluid side gasketed, and allow contact of the refrigerant with the fluid-side gaskets. These designs can be disassembled for inspection and mechanical cleaning of the fluid side. Brazed types do not have gaskets, cannot be disassembled, and are cleaned chemically. Internal leaks in brazed plates typically cannot be repaired. This type of evaporator is designed to work in a vertical orientation. Uniform distribution in direct-expansion operation is typically achieved by using a special plate design or distributor insert; flooded and pumped overfeed operations do not require distribution devices. Plate coolers are very compact and require minimal space.

Most tubular direct-expansion coolers are designed for horizontal mounting. If they are mounted vertically, performance may vary considerably from that predicted because two-phase flow heat transfer is a direction-sensitive phenomenon and dryout begins earlier in vertical upflow.

Flooded

In a flooded **shell-and-tube** cooler, refrigerant vaporizes on the outside of the tubes, which are submerged in liquid refrigerant in a closed shell. Fluid flows through the tubes as shown in Figure 2. Flooded coolers are usually used with rotary screw or centrifugal compressors to cool water, water/glycol mixtures, or brine.

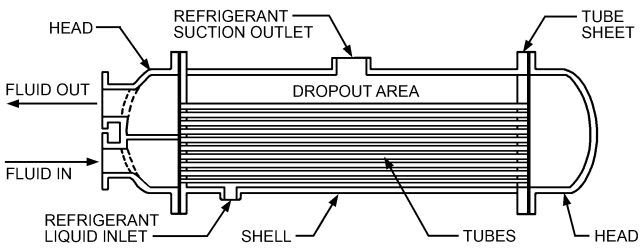

Fig. 2 Flooded Shell-and-Tube Cooler

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.5, Liquid-to-Refrigerant Heat Exchangers.

Table 1 Types of Coolers

Type of Cooler	Subtype	Usual Refrigerant Feed Device	Usual Capacity Range, kW	Commonly Used Refrigerants
Direct-expansion	Shell-and-tube	Thermal expansion valve	7 to 1800	12, 22, 134a, 404A, 407C, 410A, 500, 502,
		Electronic modulation valve	7 to 1800	507A, 717
	Tube-in-tube	Thermal expansion valve	18 to 90	12, 22, 134a, 717
	Brazed-plate	Thermal expansion valve	2 to 700	12, 22, 134a, 404A 407C, 410A, 500, 502, 507A, 508B, 717, 744
	Semiwelded plate	Thermal expansion valve	175 to 7000	12, 22, 134a, 500, 502, 507A, 717, 744
Flooded	Shell-and-tube	Low-pressure float	90 to 7000	11, 12, 22, 113, 114
		High-pressure float	90 to 21 100	123, 134a, 500, 502, 507A, 717
		Fixed orifice(s)	90 to 21 100	
		Weir	90 to 21 100	
	Spray shell-and-tube	Low-pressure float	180 to 35 000	11, 12, 13B1, 22
		High-pressure float	180 to 35 000	113, 114, 123, 134a
	Brazed-plate	Low-pressure float	2 to 700	12, 22, 134a, 500, 502, 507A, 717, 744
	Semiwelded plate	Low-pressure float	175 to 7000	12, 22, 134a, 500, 502, 507A, 717, 744
Baudelot	Flooded	Low-pressure float	35 to 350	22, 717
	Direct-expansion	Thermal expansion valve	18 to 90	12, 22, 134a, 717
Shell-and-coil	—	Thermal expansion valve	7 to 35	12, 22, 134a, 717

A refrigerant liquid/vapor mixture usually feeds into the bottom of the shell through a distributor that distributes the mixture equally under the tubes. The relatively warm fluid in the tubes heats the refrigerant liquid surrounding the tubes, causing it to boil. As bubbles rise through the space between tubes, the liquid surrounding the tubes becomes increasingly bubbly (or foamy, if much oil is present).

The refrigerant vapor must be separated from the mist generated by the boiling refrigerant to prevent liquid carryover to the compressor. The simplest separation method is provided by a dropout area between the top row of tubes and the suction connections. If this dropout area is insufficient, a coalescing filter may be required between the tubes and connections. Perry and Green (2007) give additional information on mist elimination. Another approach is to add another vessel, or "surge drum," above the suction connections. The diameter of this vessel is selected so that the velocity of the liquid droplets slows to the point where they fall back to the bottom of the surge drum. This liquid is then drained back into the flooded cooler.

The size of tubes, number of tubes, and number of passes should be set to maintain fluid velocity typically between 1 and 2.4 m/s for copper alloy tubing. Velocities beyond these limits may be used if the fluid is free of suspended abrasives and fouling substances (Ayub and Jones 1987; Sturley 1975) or if the tubing is manufactured from special alloys, such as titanium and stainless steel, that have better resistance to erosion. In some cases, the minimum velocity may be determined by a lower Reynolds number limit to minimize precipitation fouling and corrosion issues.

One variation of this cooler is the **spray shell-and-tube** cooler. In large-diameter coolers where the refrigerant's heat transfer coefficient is adversely affected by the refrigerant pressure, liquid can be sprayed to cover the tubes rather than flooding them. A mechanical pump circulates liquid from the bottom of the cooler to the spray heads.

Flooded shell-and-tube coolers are generally unsuitable for other than horizontal orientation.

In a **flooded plate** cooler (Figure 3), refrigerant vaporizes in vertical channels between corrugated plates with the liquid inlet at the bottom and the vapor outlet at the top (i.e., vertical upflow). The warm fluid flow may be either counter or parallel to the refrigerant flow. Both thermosiphon (gravity feed) and pumped overfeed operation are used. Surge drums are required for pumped overfeed operation but usually not for thermosiphon operation because the corrugated plates demist flow under most conditions.

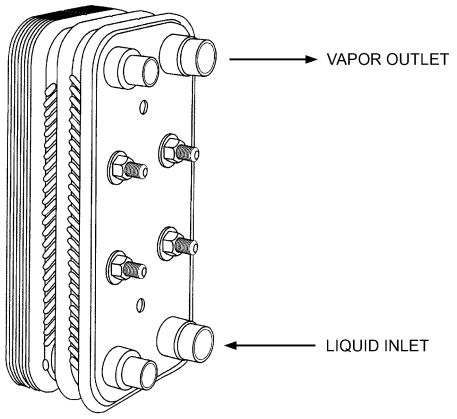

Fig. 3 Flooded Plate Cooler

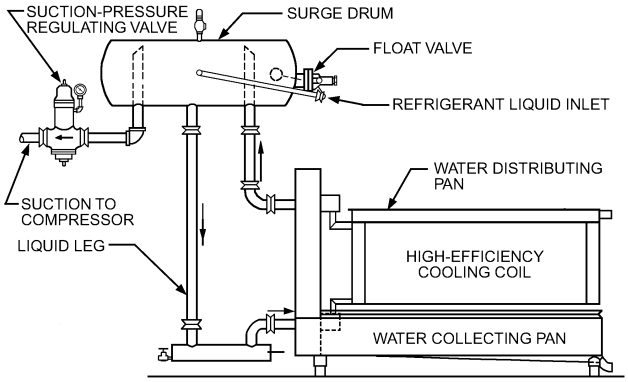

Fig. 4 Baudelot Cooler

Baudelot

Baudelot coolers (Figure 4) are used to cool a fluid to near its freezing point in industrial, food, and dairy applications. In this cooler, fluid circulates over the outside of vertical plates, which are easy to clean. The inside surface of the plates is cooled by evaporating the refrigerant. The fluid to be cooled is distributed uniformly along the top of the heat exchanger and then flows by gravity to a collection pan below. The cooler may be enclosed by insulated walls to avoid unnecessary loss of refrigeration.

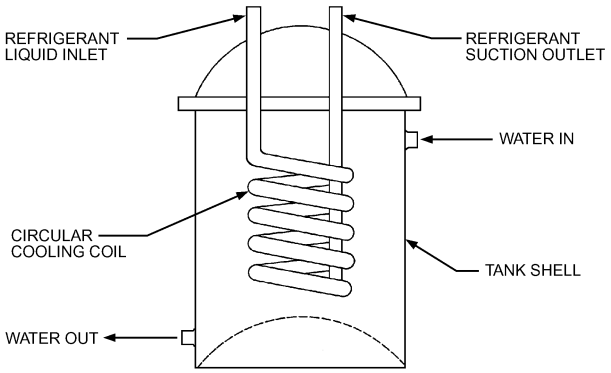

Fig. 5 Shell-and-Coil Cooler

R-717 (ammonia) is commonly used with flooded Baudelot coolers using conventional gravity feed with a surge drum. A low-pressure float valve maintains a suitable refrigerant liquid level in the surge drum. Baudelot coolers using other common refrigerants are generally direct-expansion, with thermostatic expansion valves.

Shell-and-Coil

A shell-and-coil cooler is a tank containing the fluid to be cooled with a simple coiled tube used to cool the fluid. This type of cooler has the advantage of cold fluid storage to offset peak loads. In some models, the tank can be opened for cleaning. Most applications are at low capacities (e.g., for bakeries, for photographic laboratories, and to cool drinking water).

The coiled tube containing the refrigerant can be either inside the tank (Figure 5) or attached to the outside of the tank in a way that allows heat transfer.

2. HEAT TRANSFER

Heat transfer for liquid coolers can be expressed by the following steady-state heat transfer equation:

$$q = UA\Delta t_m \tag{1}$$

where

q = total heat transfer rate, W
Δt_m = mean temperature difference, K
A = heat transfer surface area associated with U, m^2
U = overall heat transfer coefficient, W/(m$^2 \cdot$ K)

The area A can be calculated if the geometry of the cooler is known. Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describes the calculation of the mean temperature difference.

This chapter discusses the components of U, but not in depth. U may be calculated by one of the following equations.

Based on inside surface area

$$U = \frac{1}{1/h_i + [A_i/(A_o h_o)] + (t/k)(A_i/A_m) + r_{fi}} \tag{2}$$

Based on outside surface area

$$U = \frac{1}{[A_o/(A_i h_i)] + 1/h_o + (t/k)(A_o/A_m) + r_{fo}} \tag{3}$$

where

h_i = inside heat transfer coefficient based on inside surface area, W/(m$^2 \cdot$ K)
h_o = outside heat transfer coefficient based on outside surface area, W/(m$^2 \cdot$ K)
A_o = outside heat transfer surface area, m^2
A_i = inside heat transfer surface area, m^2
A_m = mean heat transfer area of metal wall, m^2
k = thermal conductivity of heat transfer material, W/(m $\cdot$ K)
t = thickness of heat transfer surface (tube wall thickness), m
r_{fi} = fouling factor of fluid side based on inside surface area, (m$^2 \cdot$ K)/W
r_{fo} = fouling factor of fluid side based on outside surface area, (m$^2 \cdot$ K)/W

Note: If fluid is on inside, multiply r_{fi} by A_o/A_i to find r_{fo}.
If fluid is on outside, multiply r_{fo} by A_i/A_o to find r_{fi}.

These equations can be applied to incremental sections of the heat exchanger to include local effects on the value of U, and then the increments summed to obtain a more accurate design.

Heat Transfer Coefficients

The refrigerant-side coefficient usually increases with (1) an increase in cooler load, (2) a decrease in suction superheat, (3) a decrease in oil concentration, or (4) an increase in saturated suction temperature. The amount of increase or decrease depends on the type of cooler. Schlager et al. (1989) and Zürcher et al. (1998) discuss the effects of oil in direct-expansion coolers. Flooded coolers have a relatively small change in heat transfer coefficient as a result of a change in load, whereas a direct-expansion cooler shows a significant increase with an increase in load. A Wilson plot of test data (Briggs and Young 1969; McAdams 1954) can show actual values for the refrigerant-side coefficient of a given cooler design. Collier and Thome (1994), Thome (1990, 2003), and Webb (1994) provide additional information on predicting refrigerant-side heat transfer coefficients.

The fluid-side coefficient is determined by cooler geometry, fluid flow rate, and fluid properties (viscosity, specific heat, thermal conductivity, and density) (Palen and Taborek 1969; Wolverine Tube 1984, 2004-2010). For a given fluid, the fluid-side coefficient increases with fluid flow rate because of increased turbulence and with fluid temperature because of improvement of fluid properties as temperature increases.

The heat transfer coefficient in direct-expansion and flooded coolers increases significantly with fluid flow. The effect of flow is smaller for Baudelot and shell-and-coil coolers.

An enhanced heat transfer surface can increase the heat transfer coefficient of coolers in the following ways:

- It increases heat transfer area, thereby increasing the overall heat transfer rate and reducing the thermal resistance of fouling, even if the refrigerant-side heat transfer coefficient is unchanged.
- Where flow of fluid or refrigerant is low, it increases turbulence at the surface and mixes fluid at the surface with fluid away from the surface. For stratified internal flows of refrigerants, it may convert the flow to complete wetting of the tube perimeter.
- In flooded coolers, an enhanced refrigerant-side surface may provide more and better nucleation points to promote boiling of refrigerant.

Pais and Webb (1991) and Thome (1990) describe many enhanced surfaces used in flooded coolers. The enhanced surface geometries provide substantially higher boiling coefficients than integral finned tubes. Nucleate pool boiling data are provided by Webb and Pais (1991). The boiling process in the tube bundle of a flooded cooler may be enhanced by forced-convection effects. This is basically an additive effect, in which the local boiling coefficient is the sum of the nucleate boiling coefficient and the forced-convection effect. Webb et al. (1989) describe an empirical method to predict flooded cooler performance, recommending row-by-row calculations.

Based on this model, Webb and Apparao (1990) present the results of calculations using a computer program. The results show some performance differences of various internal and external surface geometries. As an example, Figure 6 shows the contribution of nucleate pool boiling to the overall refrigerant heat transfer coefficient for an integral finned tube and an enhanced tube as a function of the tube row. Forced convection predominates with the integral finned tube.

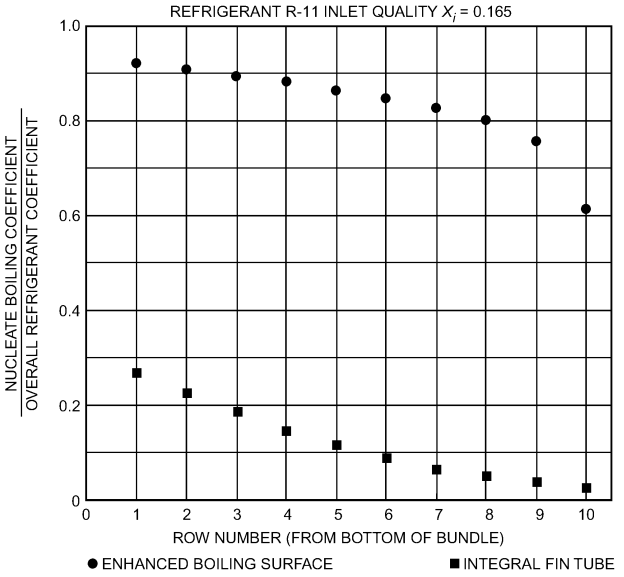

Fig. 6 Nucleate Boiling Contribution to Total Refrigerant Heat Transfer

ASHRAE research projects RP-725 (Chyu 1995) and RP-668 (Moeykens et al. 1995) studied spray evaporation performance in ammonia and halocarbon refrigerant systems. Moeykens et al. investigated shell-side heat transfer performance for commercially available enhanced surface tubes in a spray evaporation environment. The study determined that spray evaporation heat transfer can yield shell-side heat transfer coefficients equal to or greater than those found with enhanced nucleate boiling surface tubes in the flooded boiling environment. Moeykens and Pate (1996) describe an enhancement to shell-side heat transfer performance generated with small concentrations of oil (<2.5%) in spray evaporation. They attribute the improvement to foaming, which enhances heat transfer performance in the upper rows of large tube bundles operating in flooded boiling mode.

Gupte and Webb (1995a, 1995b) investigated convective vaporization in triangular enhanced tube bundles. They proposed a modified Chen superposition model that predicts the overall convective/vaporization coefficient as the sum of the single tube nucleate pool boiling coefficient and a weighted contribution of a single-phase convective coefficient.

Casciaro and Thome (2001a, 2001b) provide a comprehensive review of thermal design methods for flooded evaporators. For direct-expansion evaporators, Kattan et al. (1998) proposed a flow-pattern-based method that includes effects of flow stratification at low flow rates and onset of dryout at high vapor qualities. Zürcher et al. (1998) in ASHRAE research project RP-800 added a method to predict the adverse effect of oil on local flow boiling heat transfer coefficients to the Kattan-Thome-Favrat model.

Fouling Factors

Over time, most fluids foul the fluid-side heat transfer surface, reducing the cooler's overall heat transfer coefficient. If fouling is expected to be a problem, a mechanically cleanable cooler should be used, such as a flooded, Baudelot, or cleanable direct-expansion tube-in-tube cooler. Direct-expansion shell-and-tube, shell-and-coil, and brazed-plate coolers can be cleaned chemically. Flooded coolers and direct-expansion tube-in-tube coolers with enhanced fluid-side heat transfer surfaces tend to be self-cleaning because of high fluid turbulence, so a smaller fouling factor can probably be used for these coolers. Water quality in closed chilled-water loops has been studied as part of ASHRAE-sponsored research (RP-560). Haider et al. (1991) found little potential for fouling in such systems in a field survey. Experimental work with various tube geometries by Haider et al. (1992) confirmed that negligible fouling occurs in closed-loop evaporator tubes at 1 to 1.5 m/s and 2.1 m/s water velocities. AHRI *Standard* 480 discusses fouling calculations.

The refrigerant side of the cooler is not subject to fouling, and a fouling factor need not be included for that side.

Wall Resistance

Typically, the t/k term in Equations (2) and (3) may be negligible for material with high thermal conductivity. However, with low-thermal-conductivity material or thick-walled tubing, it may become significant. Refer to Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* and to Chapter 39 of this volume for further details.

3. PRESSURE DROP

Fluid Side

Pressure drop is usually minimal in Baudelot and shell-and-coil coolers but must be considered in direct-expansion and flooded coolers. Both direct-expansion and flooded coolers rely on turbulent fluid flow to improve heat transfer. This turbulence is obtained at the expense of pressure drop.

For air-conditioning, pressure drop is commonly limited to 70 kPa to keep pump size and energy cost reasonable. For flooded coolers, compare also Chapter 39 for a discussion of pressure drop for flow in tubes. Pressure drop for fluid flow in shell-and-tube direct-expansion coolers depends greatly on tube and baffle geometry. The following equation projects the change in pressure drop caused by a change in flow:

$$\text{New pressure drop} = \text{Original pressure drop}\left[\frac{\text{New rate}}{\text{Original rate}}\right]^{1.8} \quad (4)$$

Refrigerant Side

The refrigerant-side pressure drop must be considered for direct-expansion, shell-and-coil, brazed-plate, and (sometimes) Baudelot coolers. When there is a pressure drop on the refrigerant side, the refrigerant inlet and outlet pressures and corresponding saturated temperature are different. This difference changes the mean temperature difference, which affects the total heat transfer rate. If pressure drop is high, expansion valve operation may be affected because of reduced pressure drop across the valve. This pressure drop varies, depending on the refrigerant used, operating temperature, and type of tubing. For flooded evaporators, Casciaro and Thome (2001b) summarize prediction methods as part of ASHRAE research project RP-1089. For direct-expansion evaporators, Ould Didi et al. (2002) describe seven prediction methods, compare them to data for five refrigerants, and provide recommendations on the best choice.

4. VESSEL DESIGN

Mechanical Requirements

Pressure vessels must be constructed and tested under the rules of national, state, and local codes. The ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*, Section VIII, gives guidance on rules and exemptions.

The more common applicable codes and standards are as follows:

1. AHRI *Standard* 480 covers industry criteria for standard equipment, standard safety provisions, marking, and recommended rating requirements.
2. ASHRAE *Standard* 24 covers recommended testing methods for measuring liquid cooler capacity.
3. ASHRAE *Standard* 15 involves specific design criteria, use of materials, and testing. It refers to the ASME *Boiler and Pressure*

Vessel Code, Section VIII, for refrigerant-containing sides of pressure vessels, where applicable. Factory test pressures are specified, and minimum design working pressures are given. This code requires pressure-limiting and pressure-relief devices on refrigerant-containing systems, as applicable, and defines setting and capacity requirements for these devices.

4. ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*, Section VIII, Unfired Pressure Vessels, covers safety aspects of design and construction. Most states require coolers to meet ASME requirements if they fall within the scope of the ASME code. Some of the exceptions from meeting the ASME requirements are as follows:
   - Cooler shell inner diameter (ID) is 150 mm or less.
   - Pressure is 100 kPa (gage) or less.
   - The fluid portion of the cooler need not be built to the requirements of the ASME code if the fluid is water, the design pressure does not exceed 2.07 MPa (gage), and the design temperature does not exceed 99°C.

   Coolers meeting ASME code requirements have an ASME stamp, which is a U or UM inside a four-leaf clover. The U can be used for all coolers, and the UM can be used for small coolers.
5. Underwriters Laboratories (UL) *Standard* 207 covers specific design criteria, use of materials, testing, and initial approval by Underwriters Laboratories. A cooler with the ASME U or UM stamp does not require UL approval.

Design Pressure. On the refrigerant side, select design pressure per ASHRAE *Standard* 15. Standby temperature and the temperature encountered during shipping of chillers with a refrigerant charge should also be considered.

Required fluid-side (water-side) pressure varies, depending largely on (1) static pressure, (2) pump pressure, (3) transients caused by pump start-up, and (4) valve closing.

Chemical Requirements

The following chemical requirements are given by NACE (1985) and Perry and Green (2007).

R-717 (Ammonia). Carbon steel and cast iron are the most widely used materials for ammonia systems. Stainless steel alloys are satisfactory but more costly. Avoid copper and high-copper alloys because they are attacked by ammonia when moisture is present. Aluminum and aluminum alloys may be used with caution.

Halocarbon Refrigerants. Almost all common metals and alloys are used satisfactorily with these refrigerants. Exceptions where water may be present include magnesium and aluminum alloys containing more than 2% magnesium. Zinc is not recommended for use with R-113; it is more chemically reactive than other common construction metals and, therefore, it is usually avoided when other halogenated hydrocarbons are used as refrigerants. Under some conditions with moisture present, halocarbon refrigerants form acids that attack steel and even nonferrous metals. This problem does not commonly occur in properly cleaned and dehydrated systems. ASHRAE *Standard* 15, paragraph 9.1.2, states that "aluminum, zinc, magnesium, or their alloys shall not be used in contact with methyl chloride," or magnesium alloys with any halogenated refrigerant.

Water. Relatively pure water can be satisfactory with both ferrous and nonferrous metals. Brackish water, seawater, and some river water are quite corrosive to iron and steel and also to copper, aluminum, and many alloys of these metals. Consult a reputable water consultant who knows the local water condition. Chemical treatment by pH control, inhibitor applications, or both may be required. Where this is not feasible, more noble construction material or special coatings must be used. Aluminum should not be used in the presence of other metals in water circuits.

Brines. Ferrous metal and a few nonferrous alloys are almost universally used with sodium chloride and calcium chloride brines. Copper alloys can be used if adequate quantities of sodium dichromate are added and caustic soda is used to neutralize the solution. Even with ferrous metal, brines should be treated periodically to hold pH near neutral.

Ethylene glycol and propylene glycol are stable compounds that are less corrosive than chloride brines.

Electrical Requirements

When the fluid being cooled is electrically conductive, the system must be grounded to prevent electrochemical corrosion.

5. APPLICATION CONSIDERATIONS

Refrigerant Flow Control

Direct-Expansion Coolers. The constant superheat thermal expansion valve is the most common control used, located directly upstream of the cooler. A thermal bulb strapped to the suction line leaving the cooler senses refrigerant temperature. The valve can be adjusted to produce a constant suction superheat during steady operation. If refrigerant pressure drop between the expansion valve and the thermal bulb is significant, use an externally equalized expansion valve.

The thermal expansion valve adjustment is commonly set at a suction superheat of 4.5 to 5.5 K, which is sufficient to ensure that liquid is not carried into the compressor. Direct-expansion cooler performance is affected greatly by superheat setting. Reduced superheat improves cooler performance; thus, suction superheat should be set as low as possible while avoiding liquid carryover to the compressor.

Flooded Coolers. As the name implies, flooded coolers must have good liquid refrigerant coverage of the tubes to achieve good performance. Liquid level control in a flooded cooler becomes the principal issue in flow control. Some systems are designed critically charged, so that when all the liquid refrigerant is delivered to the cooler, it is just enough for good tube coverage. In these systems, an orifice is often used as the throttling device between condenser and cooler.

Level-sensing devices are another option. Typically, a high-side float valve or level-sensing system can meter flow to the cooler at a controlled rate based on the condenser liquid level. For more direct control of liquid level in the cooler, a low-side float valve or level-sensing system can be used to control flow of entering refrigerant based on the level in the cooler itself. Because of the volatile nature of boiling inside the flooded cooler and the potential for false level readings, consider installing a low-side liquid level sensing device.

Freeze Prevention

Freeze prevention must be considered for coolers operating near the fluid's freezing point. In some coolers, freezing causes extensive damage. Two methods can be used for freeze protection: (1) hold saturated suction pressure above the fluid freezing point or (2) shut the system off if fluid temperature approaches the freezing point.

A suction-pressure regulator can hold the saturated suction pressure above the fluid's freezing point. A low-pressure cutout can shut the system off before the saturated suction pressure drops below the freezing point of the fluid. The leaving fluid temperature can be monitored to cut the system off before a danger of freezing, usually about 2 K above the fluid freezing temperature. It is recommended that both methods be used.

Baudelot, shell-and-coil, brazed-plate, and direct-expansion shell-and-tube coolers are all somewhat resistant to damage caused by freezing and ideal for applications where freezing may be a problem.

If a cooler is installed in an unconditioned area, possible freezing caused by low ambient temperature must be considered. If the cooler is used only when ambient temperature is above freezing, drain the fluid from the cooler for cold weather. Alternatively, if the cooler is used year-round, the following methods can be used to prevent freezing:

- Heat tape or other heating device to keep cooler above freezing
- For water, adding an appropriate amount of ethylene glycol
- Continuous pump operation

Oil Return

Most compressors discharge a small percentage of oil in the discharge gas. This oil mixes with condensed refrigerant in the condenser and flows to the cooler. Because the oil is nonvolatile, it does not evaporate and may collect in the cooler.

In direct-expansion coolers, gas velocity in the tubes and suction gas header is usually sufficient to carry oil from the cooler into the suction line. From there, with proper piping design, it can be carried back to the compressor. At light load and low temperature, oil may gather in the superheat section of the cooler, detracting from performance. For this reason, operating refrigerant circuits at light load for long periods should be avoided, especially under low-temperature conditions. Some oil hold-up threshold measurements were presented by Zürcher et al. (1998) in ASHRAE research project RP-800.

In flooded coolers, vapor velocity above the tube bundle is usually insufficient to return oil up the suction line, and oil tends to accumulate in the cooler. With time, depending on the compressor oil loss rate, oil concentration in the cooler may become large. When concentration exceeds about 1%, heat transfer performance may be adversely affected if enhanced tubing is used.

It is common in flooded coolers to take some oil-rich liquid and return it to the compressor on a continuing basis, to establish a rate of return equal to the compressor oil loss rate.

Maintenance

Cooler maintenance centers around (1) safety and (2) cleaning the fluid side. Periodically inspect the cooler for any weakening of its pressure boundaries. Visual inspection for corrosion, erosion, and any deformities should be included, and any pressure relief device should also be inspected. The cooler's insurer may require regular inspection. If the fluid side is subjected to fouling, it may require periodic cleaning (either mechanical or chemical). The manufacturer or a service organization experienced in cooler maintenance should have details for cleaning.

Insulation

A cooler operating at a saturated suction temperature lower than the ambient-air dew point should be insulated to prevent condensation. Direct-expansion coolers installed where the ambient temperature may drop below the process fluid's freezing point should also be insulated and wrapped with heat tape, to prevent the fluid from freezing and damaging the cooler during *off* periods. Chapters 23 and 25 to 27 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describe insulation in more detail.

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CHAPTER 43

LIQUID-CHILLING SYSTEMS

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LIQUID-CHILLING systems cool water, brine, or other secondary coolant for air conditioning or refrigeration. The chiller may be either factory-assembled and wired or shipped in sections for erection in the field. The most frequent application is water chilling for building air conditioning, although brine cooling for low-temperature refrigeration and chilling fluids in industrial processes are also common. The heat that is removed from the chilled liquid along with the heat from the compressor work input is typically rejected by the condenser into an air or water heat sink. Alternatively, that heat can be used for beneficial building or process heating, in which case the chiller is referred to as a **heat pump** or simply a **heater**.

The basic components of a vapor-compression chiller include one or more compressor(s), liquid cooler (evaporator), condenser, compressor drive(s), liquid-refrigerant expansion or flow-control device, and control center. It may also include a receiver, economizer, expansion turbine, and/or subcooler. In addition, auxiliary components may be used, such as a lubricant cooler, lubricant separator, lubricant-return device, purge unit, lubricant pump, refrigerant transfer unit, refrigerant vents, and/or additional control valves.

For information on absorption equipment, see Chapter 18 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

1. GENERAL CHARACTERISTICS

1.1 PRINCIPLES OF OPERATION

Liquid (usually water or water/glycol mixture) enters the cooler, where it is chilled by liquid refrigerant evaporating at a lower temperature. The refrigerant evaporates as it absorbs heat from the liquid and is drawn into the compressor. The compressor performs work on the refrigerant gas, which increases the pressure and temperature so that it may reject the evaporator heat and heat of compression to the cooling medium in the condenser. The condenser cooling medium, typically water, is heated in the process. The condensed liquid refrigerant then flows back to the evaporator through an expansion device, where some of the liquid refrigerant changes to vapor (flashes) as pressure drops. Flashing cools the liquid to the saturated temperature at evaporator pressure. The following modifications (sometimes combined for maximum effect) reduce flash gas and increase the net refrigeration per unit of power consumption.

Subcooling. Condensed refrigerant may be subcooled below its saturated condensing temperature in either the subcooler section of a water-cooled condenser or a separate heat exchanger. Subcooling reduces flashing and increases the refrigeration effect in the chiller.

Economizing. This process can occur either in a direct-expansion (DX), an expansion turbine, or a flash system. In a **DX system**, the main liquid refrigerant is usually cooled in the shell of a shell-and-tube heat exchanger, at condensing pressure, from the saturated condensing temperature to within several degrees of the intermediate saturated temperature. Before cooling, a small portion of the liquid flashes and evaporates in the tube side of the heat exchanger to cool the main liquid flow. Although subcooled, the liquid is still at the condensing pressure.

An **expansion turbine** extracts rotating energy as a portion of the refrigerant vaporizes. As in the DX system, the remaining liquid is supplied to the cooler at intermediate pressure.

In a **flash system**, the entire liquid flow is expanded to intermediate pressure in a vessel that supplies liquid to the cooler at saturated intermediate pressure; however, the liquid is at intermediate pressure.

Flash gas enters the compressor either at an intermediate stage of a multistage centrifugal compressor, at the intermediate stage of an integral two-stage reciprocating compressor, at an intermediate pressure port of a screw compressor, or at the inlet of a high-pressure stage on a multistage reciprocating or screw compressor.

Liquid Injection. Condensed liquid is throttled to the intermediate pressure and injected into the second-stage suction of the compressor to prevent excessively high discharge temperatures and, in the case of centrifugal machines, to reduce noise. For screw compressors, condensed liquid is injected into a port fixed at slightly below discharge pressure to provide lubricant cooling.

1.2 COMMON LIQUID-CHILLING SYSTEMS

Basic Chiller

The refrigeration components of a basic water-cooled chiller are shown in Figure 1. Chilled water enters the cooler at 14°C, for example, and leaves at 6°C. Condenser water leaves a cooling tower at 30°C, enters the condenser, and returns to the cooling tower near 38°C. Condensers may also be cooled by air or evaporation of water. This system, with a single compressor and one refrigerant circuit

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.1, Positive Displacement Compressors, and TC 8.2, Centrifugal Machines.

with a water-cooled condenser, is used extensively to chill water for air conditioning because it is relatively simple and compact.

Multiple-Chiller Systems

A multiple-chiller system has two or more chillers connected by parallel or series piping to a common chilled-liquid distribution system. Multiple chillers offer operational flexibility, standby capacity, and less disruptive maintenance. The chillers can be sized to handle a base load and increments of a variable load to allow each chiller to operate at its most efficient point.

Multiple-chiller systems offer some standby capacity if repair work must be done on one chiller. Using multiple smaller chillers rather than one larger chiller may reduce starting in-rush current as well as power costs at partial-load conditions. Maintenance can be scheduled for one chiller during part-load times, and sufficient cooling can still be provided by the remaining unit(s). These advantages require an increase in installed cost and space, however. Traditionally, flow was held constant through the chillers for stable control. Today, variable-flow chilled-water systems are preferred in many applications to achieve plant energy and first-cost savings. Chillers selected for these applications should be capable of turning the chilled-liquid flow down to at least 60% of the design flow to ensure intended pumping energy savings can be achieved. Both variable-flow and primary/ secondary hydronic systems are discussed in further detail in Chapter 13.

In the parallel arrangement, when design chilled-water temperature is above about 7°C, all units should be controlled by the combined exit liquid temperature or by the return water temperature (RWT), because overchilling will not cause dangerously low water temperature in the operating machine(s). Chilled-water temperature can be used to cycle one unit off when it drops below a capacity that can be matched by the remaining units.

When the design chilled-water temperature is below about 7°C, each machine should be controlled by its own chilled-water temperature, both to prevent dangerously low evaporator temperatures and to avoid frequent shutdowns by low-temperature cutout. The temperature differential setting of the RWT must be adjusted carefully to prevent short-cycling caused by the step increase in chilled-water temperature when one chiller is cycled off. These control arrangements are shown in Figures 2 and 3.

In the **series arrangement**, the evaporator vessel must handle the entire system flow in both chillers, so they should be selected with the combined pressure drop in mind. No overchilling by either unit is required, and compressor power consumption is lower than for the parallel arrangement at partial loads. Each chiller provides part of the overall system temperature differential. Because the first chiller operates at a higher evaporator temperature (meaning lower lift), it operates more efficiently than the second chiller, thereby improving overall system efficiency. In addition, because evaporator temperature never drops below the design value (because no overchilling is necessary), the chances of evaporator freeze-up are minimized. However, the chiller should still be protected by a low-temperature safety control. If operating flexibility, standby capacity, or ability to operate on one chiller during maintenance of the other are desired, the piping must be arranged such that all flow can bypass either chiller and the system can operate on the non-bypassed chiller. This means that each chiller should be specified to be able to provide the overall system temperature differential.

If the condenser water side of the chillers is to be designed in series, the condensers are best piped in a counterflow arrangement so that the first machine is provided with warmer condenser and chilled water and the second machine is provided with colder entering condenser and chilled water. Refrigerant compression for each unit is nearly the same. If about 55% of design cooling capacity is assigned to the first machine and about 45% to the second machine, identical units can be used. In this way, either machine can provide the same

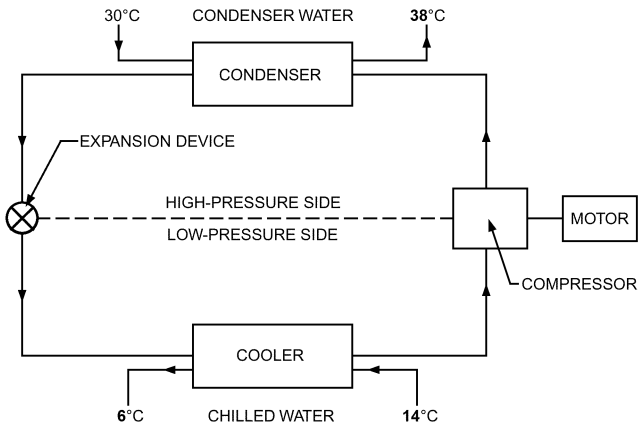

Fig. 1 Equipment Diagram for Basic Liquid Chiller

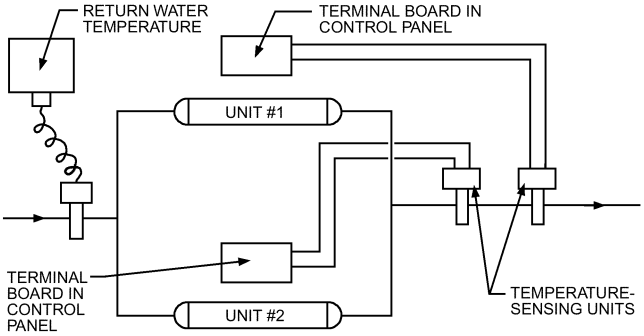

Fig. 2 Parallel-Operation High Design Water Leaving Coolers (Approximately 7°C and Above)

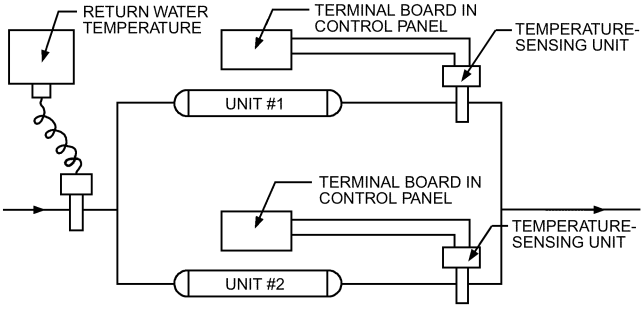

Fig. 3 Parallel-Operation Low Design Water Leaving Coolers (Below Approximately 7°C)

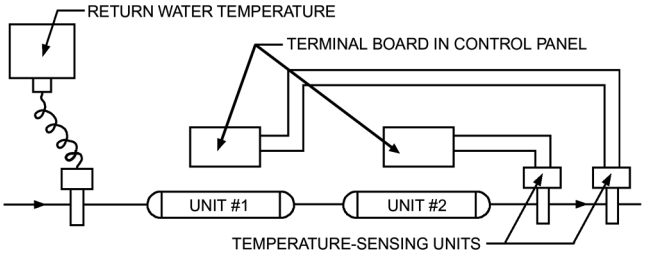

Fig. 4 Series Operation

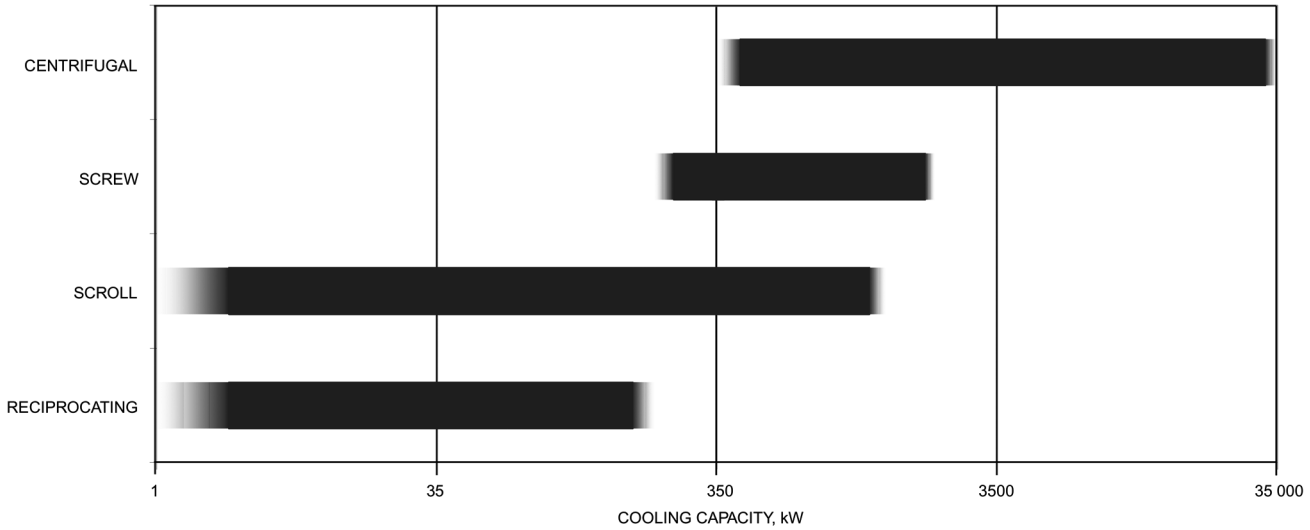

Fig. 5 Approximate Liquid Chiller Availability Range by Compressor Type

standby capacity if the other is down, and the machines may be interchanged to equalize the number of operating hours on each.

A control system for two machines in series is shown in Figure 4. Both units are modulated to a certain capacity; then, one unit shuts down, leaving less than 100% load on the operating machine.

One machine should be shut down as soon as possible, with the remaining unit carrying the full load. This not only reduces the number of operating hours on a unit, but also leads to less total power consumption because the coefficient of performance (COP) tends to decrease below full-load value when unit load drops much below 50%.

1.3 SELECTION

The largest factor that determines total liquid chiller owning cost is the cooling load size; therefore, the total required chiller capacity should be calculated accurately. The practice of adding 10 to 20% to load estimates is unnecessary because of the availability of accurate load estimating methods, and it proportionately increases costs of equipment purchase, installation, and the poor efficiency resulting from wasted power. Oversized equipment can also cause operational difficulties such as frequent on/off cycling or surging of centrifugal machines at low loads. The penalty for a small underestimation of cooling load, however, is not serious. On the few design-load days of the year, increased chilled-liquid temperature is often acceptable. However, for some industrial or commercial loads, a safety factor can be added to the load estimate.

Use the life-cycle cost (discussed in Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*) to minimize overall purchase and operating costs. Total owning cost is comprised of the following:

- **Equipment price.** Each machine type and/or manufacturer's model should include all necessary auxiliaries such as starters and vibration mounts. If these are not included, their price should be added to the base price. Include associated equipment, such as condenser water pump, tower, and piping.
- **Installation cost.** Factory-packaged machines are both less expensive to install and usually considerably more compact, thus saving space. The cost of field assembly must also be evaluated.
- **Energy cost.** Using an estimated load schedule and part-load power consumption curves furnished by the manufacturer, a year's energy cost should be calculated.
- **Water cost.** With water-cooled towers, the cost of acquisition, water treatment, tower blowdown, and overflow water should be included.
- **Maintenance cost.** Each bidder may be asked to quote on a maintenance contract on a competitive basis.
- **Insurance and taxes.**
- **Regulatory/codes.** Changes in regulations could require replacement of chiller fluids, upgrades of electronics, or improvements in efficiencies.

For packaged chillers that include heat recovery, system cost and performance should be compared in addition to equipment costs. For example, the heat recovery chiller installed cost should be compared with the installed cost of a chiller plus a separate heating system. Also consider the following factors: (1) energy costs, (2) maintenance requirements, (3) life expectancy of equipment, (4) standby arrangement, (5) relationship of heating to cooling loads in terms of size and concurrence, (6) effect of package selection on sizing, and (7) type of peripheral equipment.

Condensers and coolers are often available with either **liquid heads**, which require water pipes to be disconnected for tube access and maintenance, or **marine-type water boxes**, which allow tube access with water piping intact. The liquid head is less expensive. The cost of disconnecting piping must be greater than the additional cost of marine-type water boxes to justify using the latter. Typically, an elbow and union or flange connection can be installed immediately next to liquid heads to facilitate removing heads. By making sure that all specialty piping components (valves, controls, strainers, etc.) fall outside the tube bundle boundary, the liquid heads can be removed with minimal pipe disassembly.

Figure 5 shows types of liquid chillers and their ranges of capacities.

For air-cooled condenser duty, brine chilling, or other high-pressure applications from 280 to about 700 kW, scroll and screw liquid chillers are more frequently installed than centrifugals. Centrifugal liquid chillers (particularly multistage machines), however, may be applied quite satisfactorily at high pressures.

Advancements in technology, refrigerants, and manufacturer offerings all affect which compression technology is best suited for a given liquid chiller application. Centrifugal packages are typically available to about 12 MW,and field-assembled machines to about 35 MW.

1.4 CONTROL

Liquid Chiller Controls

The **chilled-liquid temperature sensor** sends an air pressure (pneumatic control) or electrical signal (electronic control) to the control circuit, which then modulates compressor capacity in response to leaving or return chilled-liquid temperature change from its set point. This control also applies to chillers used for heat recovery. Chillers used exclusively for heating use the leaving or return condenser cooling medium temperature to modulate the compressor capacity. The method of compressor capacity modulation varies depending on the type of liquid chillers:

Scroll and reciprocating chillers use combinations of involute/cylinder unloading and on/off compressor cycling of single or multiple compressors.

Centrifugal liquid chillers, driven by electric motors, commonly use adjustable prerotation vanes, which are sometimes combined with movable diffuser walls. Turbine and engine drives and inverter-driven, variable-speed electric motors allow use of speed control in addition to prerotation vane modulation, reducing power consumption at partial loads.

Screw compressor liquid chillers include a slide valve that adjusts the length of the compression path. Inverter-driven, variable-speed electric motors, turbines, and engine drives can also modulate screw compressor speed to control capacity.

In air-conditioning applications, most centrifugal and screw compressor chillers modulate from 100% to approximately 10% load. Although relatively inefficient, hot-gas bypass can be used to reduce capacity to nearly 0% with the unit in operation.

Reciprocating chillers are available with simple on/off cycling control in small capacities and with multiple steps of unloading down to 12.5% in the largest multiple-compressor units. Most intermediate sizes provide unloading to 50, 33, or 25% capacity. Hot-gas bypass can reduce capacity to nearly 0%.

The **water temperature controller** is a thermostatic device that unloads or cycles the compressor(s) when the cooling load drops below minimum unit capacity. An **anti-recycle timer** is sometimes used to limit starting frequency.

On centrifugal or screw compressor chillers, a **current limiter** or **demand limiter** limits compressor capacity during periods of possible high power consumption (such as pulldown) to prevent current draw from exceeding the design value; such a limiter can be set to limit demand, as described in the section on Centrifugal Liquid Chillers.

Controls That Influence the Liquid Chiller

Condenser cooling water may need to be controlled to avoid falling below the manufacturer's recommended minimum limit, to regulate condenser pressure. Normally, the temperature of water leaving a cooling tower can be controlled by fans, dampers, or a water bypass around the tower. Tower bypass allows water velocity through the condenser tubes to be maintained, which prevents low-velocity fouling.

A flow-regulating valve is another common means of control. The orifice of this valve modulates in response to condenser pressure. For example, reducing pressure decreases water flow, which, in turn, raises condenser pressure to the desired minimum level.

For air-cooled or evaporative condensers, compressor discharge pressure can be controlled by cycling fans, shutting off circuits, or flooding coils with liquid refrigerant to reduce heat transfer.

A reciprocating chiller usually has a thermal expansion valve, which requires a restricted range of pressure to avoid starving the evaporator (at low pressure).

An expansion valve(s) usually controls a screw compressor chiller. Cooling tower water temperature can be allowed to fall with decreasing load from the design condition to the chiller manufacturer's recommended minimum limit.

Screw compressor chillers above 525 kW may use flooded evaporators and evaporator liquid refrigerant controls similar to those used on centrifugal chillers.

A thermal expansion valve may control a centrifugal chiller at low capacities. Higher-capacity machines may use a pilot-operated thermal control valve, an electronically controlled valve, fixed orifice(s), a high-pressure float, or even a low-side float valve to control refrigerant liquid flow to the cooler. These latter types of controls allow relatively low condenser pressures, particularly at partial loads. Also, a centrifugal machine may surge if pressure is not reduced when cooling load decreases. In addition, low pressure reduces compressor power consumption and operating noise. For these reasons, in a centrifugal installation, cooling tower water temperature should be allowed to fall naturally with decreasing load and wet-bulb temperature, except that the liquid chiller manufacturer's recommended minimum limit must be observed.

Safety Controls

Older systems often used dedicated control devices for each function of the chiller. Modern chiller systems typically use a microprocessor control center that can handle many control functions at once and can combine several control points into a single sensor. Some or all of the following safety algorithms or cutouts may be provided in a liquid-chilling package to stop compressor(s) automatically. Cutouts may be manual or automatic reset.

- **High condenser pressure.** This pressure switch opens if the compressor discharge pressure exceeds the allowable limit. It is usually a dedicated pressure switch that interrupts the chiller main run circuit to ensure a positive shutdown in an overpressure situation.
- **Low refrigerant pressure (or temperature).** This device opens when evaporator pressure (or temperature) reaches a minimum safe limit.
- **High lubricant temperature.** This device protects the compressor if loss of lubricant cooling occurs or if a bearing failure causes excessive heat generation.
- **High motor temperature.** If loss of motor cooling or overloading because of a failure of a control occurs, this device shuts down the machine. It may consist of direct-operating bimetallic thermostats, thermistors, or other sensors embedded in the stator windings; it may be located in the discharge gas stream of the compressor.
- **Motor overload.** Some small, reciprocating-compressor hermetic motors may use a directly operated overload in the power wiring to the motor. Some larger motors use pilot-operated overloads. Centrifugal and screw-compressor motors generally use starter overloads or current-limiting devices to protect against overcurrent.
- **Magnetic bearing overload.** Magnetic bearings are designed to sustain mechanical loads up to an electromagnetic threshold. Thermal, current, or proximity sensing devices are typically used along with associated controls to limit operation and protect the bearings. Sleeve or rolling element bearings are also typically provided in the bearing package to sustain dynamic forces during shutdown sequences.
- **Low lubricant sump temperature.** This switch is used either to protect against lubricant heater failure or to prevent starting after prolonged shutdown before lubricant heaters have had time to drive off refrigerant dissolved in the lubricant.
- **Low lubricant pressure.** To protect against clogged lubricant filters, blocked lubricant passageways, loss of lubricant, or a lubricant pump failure, a switch shuts down the compressor when lubricant pressure drops below a minimum safe value or if sufficient lubricant pressure is not developed shortly after the compressor starts.

- **Chilled-liquid flow interlock.** This device may not be furnished with the liquid-chilling package, but it is needed in external piping to protect against cooler freeze-up in case the liquid stops flowing. An electrical interlock is typically installed either in the factory or in the field. Most chiller control panels include a terminal for field-connecting a flow switch.
- **Condenser water flow interlock.** This device, similar to the chilled-liquid flow interlock, is sometimes used in external piping.
- **Low chilled-liquid temperature.** Sometimes called **freeze protection**, this cutout operates at a minimum safe value of leaving chilled-liquid temperature to prevent cooler freeze-up in the case of an operating control malfunction.
- **Relief valves.** In accordance with ASHRAE *Standard* 15, relief valves, rupture disks, or both, set to relieve at shell design working pressure, must be provided on most pressure vessels or on piping connected to the vessels. Fusible plugs may also be used in some locations. Pressure relief devices should be vented outdoors or to the low-pressure side, in accordance with regulations or the standard.

1.5 STANDARDS AND TESTING

AHRI *Standard* 550/590 provides requirements for rating and testing liquid-chilling machines. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 sets requirements for minimum efficiencies. Design and construction of refrigerant pressure vessels are governed by ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*, Section VIII, except when design working pressure is 103 kPa (gage) or less (as is usually the case for R-514A liquid-chilling machines). Water-side design and construction of a condenser or evaporator are not within the scope of the ASME code unless design pressure is greater than 2070 kPa or design temperature is greater than 99°C.

ASHRAE *Standard* 15 applies to all liquid chillers and new refrigerants on the market. Requirements for equipment rooms are included. Methods for measuring unit sound levels are described in AHRI *Standard* 575.

1.6 GENERAL MAINTENANCE

The following maintenance specifications apply to reciprocating, centrifugal, and screw chillers. Equipment should be neither overmaintained nor neglected. Establish a preventive maintenance schedule; items covered can vary with the nature of the application. The list is intended as a guide; in all cases, the manufacturer's specific recommendation should be followed.

Continual Monitoring

- Condenser water treatment: treatment is determined specifically for the condenser water used.
- Operating conditions: daily log sheets should be kept (either manually or automatically) to indicate trends and provide advance notice of deteriorating chillers.
- Brine quality for concentration and corrosion inhibitor levels.

Periodic Checks

- Leak check
- Purge operation
- System dryness
- Lubricant level
- Lubricant filter pressure drop
- Refrigerant quantity or level
- System pressures and temperatures
- Water flows
- Expansion valves operation

Regularly Scheduled Maintenance

- Condenser and lubricant cooler cleaning
- Evaporator cleaning on open systems
- Calibrating pressure, temperature, and flow controls
- Tightening wires and power connections
- Inspection of starter contacts and action
- Safety interlocks
- Dielectric checking of hermetic and open motors
- Tightness of hot gas valve
- Lubricant filter and drier change
- Analysis of lubricant and refrigerant
- Seal inspection
- Partial or complete valve or bearing inspection, as per manufacturer's recommendations
- Vibration levels

Extended Maintenance Checks

- Compressor guide vanes and linkage operation and wear
- Eddy current inspection of heat exchanger tubes
- Compressor teardown and inspection of rotating components
- Other components as recommended by manufacturer

2. SCROLL AND RECIPROCATING LIQUID CHILLERS

2.1 EQUIPMENT

Components and Their Functions

Scroll and reciprocating compressors described in Chapter 38 are positive-displacement machines that maintain fairly constant-volume flow rate over a wide range of pressure ratios. The following types of compressors are commonly used in liquid-chilling machines:

- Welded hermetic, to about 1055kW chiller capacity
- Semihermetic, to about 700 kW chiller capacity
- Direct-drive open, to about 1600 kW chiller capacity

Open motor-driven reciprocating liquid chillers are usually more expensive than hermetically sealed units, but have an efficiency benefit of not rejecting motor heat into the refrigeration cycle. Hermetic motors are generally suction-gas-cooled; the rotor is mounted on the compressor crankshaft.

Condensers may be evaporative, air, or water cooled. Water-cooled versions may be tube-in-tube, shell-and-coil, shell-and-tube, or plate heat exchangers. Most shell-and-tube condensers can be repaired; others must be replaced if a refrigerant-side leak occurs.

Air-cooled condensers are much more common than evaporative condensers. Less maintenance is needed for air-cooled heat exchangers than for the evaporative type. Remote condensers can be applied with condenserless packages. (Information on condensers can be found in Chapter 39.)

Coolers are usually direct expansion, in which refrigerant evaporates while flowing inside tubes or plate channels and liquid is cooled as it is guided in multiple passes over the outside of the tubes by shell-side baffles for shell and tube heat exchangers, or as liquid flows in counterflow for plate heat exchangers. Flooded coolers are sometimes used on industrial chillers. Flooded coolers maintain a level of refrigerant liquid on the shell side of the cooler, while liquid to be cooled flows through tubes inside the cooler. Tube-in-tube coolers are sometimes used with small machines; they offer low cost when repairability and installation space are not important criteria. Chapter 42 describes coolers in more detail.

The **thermal expansion** valve, capillary, or other device modulates refrigerant flow from the condenser to the cooler to maintain enough suction superheat to prevent any unevaporated refrigerant liquid from reaching the compressor. Excessively high values of superheat are avoided so that unit capacity is not reduced. (For

additional information, see Chapter 11 in the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.)

Lubricant cooling is not usually required for air conditioning. However, if it is necessary, a refrigerant-cooled coil in the crankcase or a water-cooled cooler may be used. Lubricant coolers are often used in applications that have a low suction temperature or high pressure ratio when extra lubricant cooling is needed.

Capacities and Types Available

Available capacities range from about 7 to 1600 kW. Multiple scroll and reciprocating compressor units are popular for the following reasons:

- The number of capacity increments is greater, resulting in closer liquid temperature control, lower power consumption, less current in-rush during starting, and extra standby capacity.
- Multiple refrigerant circuits are used, resulting in the potential for limited servicing or maintenance of some components while maintaining cooling.

Selection of Refrigerant

R-410A has been the primary refrigerant used in scroll chiller applications. R-134a or R-407C is frequently used in reciprocating chiller applications. R-134a or R-407C are suitable for both open and hermetic compressors. Lower global-warming-potential (GWP) refrigerants R-454B and R-32 are increasingly being used in scroll chiller applications. R-513A is a lower-GWP alternative to R134a for reciprocating chillers.

R-410A provides greater capacity than R-134a for a given compressor displacement, resulting in physically smaller compressors required. R-717 (ammonia) has similar capacity characteristics to R-407C, but, because of odor and toxicity, R-717 use in public or populated areas is restricted. However, R-717 chillers are becoming more popular because of the pull for lower-global-warming refrigerants and natural refrigerants. R-717 units are typically open-drive compressors and are piped with steel because copper cannot be used in ammonia systems.

2.2 PERFORMANCE CHARACTERISTICS AND OPERATING PROBLEMS

A distinguishing characteristic of scroll and reciprocating compressors is pressure rise impact on capacity. Pressure rise has only a slight influence on the volume flow rate of the compressor, and, therefore, scroll and reciprocating liquid chillers retain nearly full cooling capacity, even on above-design-wet-bulb days. It is well suited for air-cooled condenser operation and low-temperature refrigeration. Typical performance is shown in Figure 6 and compared with centrifugal and screw compressors. Capacity control methods include the following:

- Unloading reciprocating compressor cylinders (one at a time or in pairs)
- On/off cycling of compressors
- Pulse width modulation unloading of scroll compressors
- Hot-gas bypass
- Compressor variable-speed control
- Combination of the previous methods

Figure 7 shows the relationship between system demand and performance of a compressor with three steps of unloading. As cooling load drops to the left of fully loaded compressor line A, compressor capacity is reduced to that shown by line B, which produces the required refrigerant flow. Because cooling load varies continuously whereas machine capacity is available in fixed increments, some compressor on/off cycling or successive loading and unloading is required to maintain fairly constant liquid temperature. In practice, a good control system minimizes load/unload or on/off cycling frequency while maintaining satisfactory temperature control.

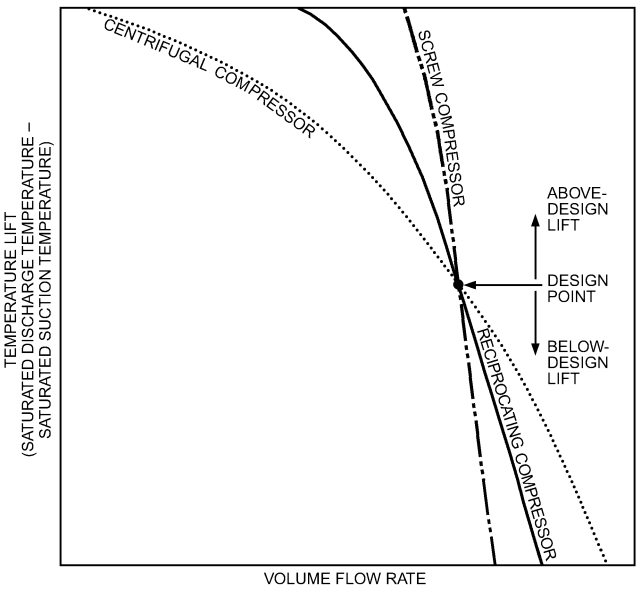

Fig. 6 Comparison of Single-Stage Centrifugal, Scroll/Reciprocating, and Screw Compressor Performance

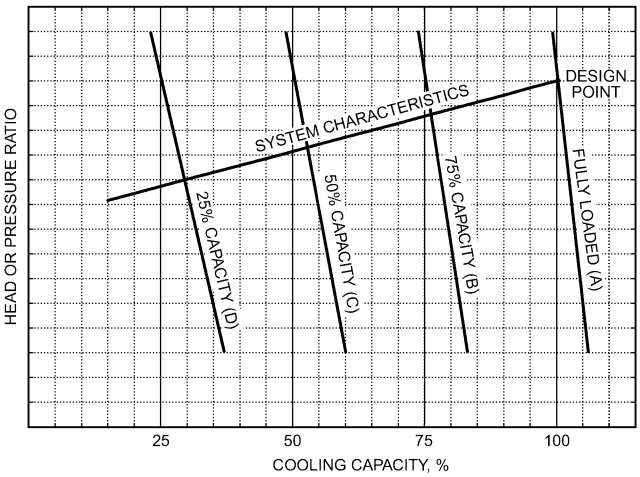

Fig. 7 Scroll and Reciprocating Liquid Chiller Performance with Three Equal Steps of Unloading

2.3 METHOD OF SELECTION

Ratings

Two types of ratings are published. The first, for a packaged liquid chiller, lists values of capacity and power consumption for many combinations of leaving condenser water and chilled-water temperatures (ambient dry-bulb temperatures for air-cooled models). The second type of rating shows capacity and power consumption for different condensing and chilled-water temperatures. This type of rating allows selection with a remote condenser that can be evaporative, water, or air cooled. Sometimes the required rate of heat rejection is also listed to aid in selecting a separate condenser.

Power Consumption

With all liquid-chilling systems, power consumption increases as condensing temperature rises. Therefore, the smallest package, with the lowest ratio of input to cooling capacity, can be used when condenser water temperature is low, the remote air-cooled condenser is relatively large, or when leaving chilled-water temperature is high. The cost of the total system, however, may not be low when liquid chiller cost is minimized. Increases in cooling tower or fan-coil cost will reduce or offset the benefits of reduced compression ratio. Life-cycle costs (initial cost plus operating expenses) should be evaluated.

Fouling

A fouling allowance of 0.044 $(m^2 \cdot K)/kW$ is included in manufacturers' ratings in accordance with AHRI *Standard* 550/590. However, fouling factors greater than 0.044 should be considered if water conditions are not ideal.

2.4 CONTROL CONSIDERATIONS

Scroll and reciprocating chillers are most commonly distinguished from centrifugal and screw compressor-operated chillers by their use of increments of capacity reduction rather than continuous modulation. Therefore, special arrangements must be used to establish precise chilled-liquid temperature control while maintaining stable operation free from excessive on/off cycling of compressors or unnecessary loading and unloading of cylinders or scroll modulation.

To help provide good temperature control, return chilled-liquid temperature sensing is normally used by units with steps of capacity control. The resulting flywheel effect in the chilled-liquid circuit damps out excessive cycling. Leaving chilled-liquid temperature sensing prevents excessively low leaving chilled-liquid temperatures if chilled-liquid flow falls significantly below the design value. It may not provide stable operation, however, if rapid load changes are encountered.

An example of a basic control circuit for a packaged scroll/reciprocating chiller with three steps of unloading is shown in Figure 8. The on/off switch controls start-up and starts the programmed timer. Assuming that the flow switch, field interlocks, and chiller safety devices are closed, pressing the momentarily closed reset button energizes control relay C1, locking in the safety circuit and the motor-starting circuit. When the timer completes its program, timer switch 1 closes and timer switch 2 opens. Timer relay TR energizes, stopping the timer motor. When timer switch 1 closes, the motor-starting circuit is completed and the motor contactor holding coil is energized, starting the compressor.

The four-stage thermostat controls the compressor capacity in response to demand. Cylinders are loaded and unloaded, or scroll pulse width modulation is controlled, by deenergizing and energizing the unloader solenoids. If load is reduced so that return water temperature drops to a predetermined setting, the unit shuts down until demand for cooling increases.

Opening a device in the safety circuit deenergizes control relay C1 and shuts down the compressor. The liquid line solenoid is also deenergized. Manual reset is required to restart. The crankcase heater is often energized whenever the compressor is shut down to prevent liquid refrigerant migration to the compressor oil sump, which can impact reliability from oil dilution and flooding at startup.

If the automatic reset, low-pressure cutout opens, the compressor shuts down, but the liquid line solenoid remains energized. The timer relay TR is deenergized, causing the timer to start and complete its program before the compressor can be restarted. This prevents rapid cycling of the compressor under low-pressure conditions. A time delay low-pressure switch can also be used for this purpose with the proper circuitry.

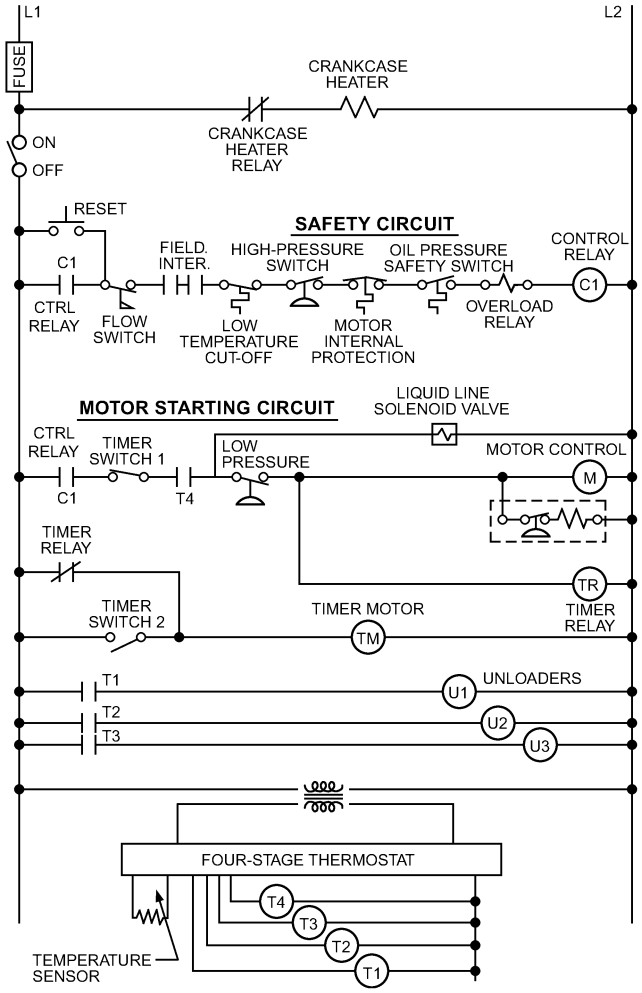

Fig. 8 Scroll/Reciprocating Liquid Chiller Control System

2.5 SPECIAL APPLICATIONS

For multiple-chiller applications and a 6 K chilled-liquid temperature range, a parallel chilled-liquid arrangement is common because of the high cooler pressure drop resulting from the series arrangement. For a large (10 K) range, however, the series arrangement eliminates the need for overcooling when only one unit is operating. Special coolers with low water-pressure drop may also be used to reduce total chilled-water pressure drop in the series arrangement.

Air-cooled scroll and reciprocating liquid chillers are often configured with a reversing valve in the refrigerant circuit and applied as heat pump chillers. Such chillers have the ability to seasonally be configured for either heating or cooling duty. Glycol is required in the water loop to prevent freezing in cold climates. In addition, air-cooled scroll and reciprocating chillers can be applied with a fluid to refrigerant heat exchanger in the compressor discharge line that desuperheats the discharge gas and reclaims that heat for other building heating needs.

3. CENTRIFUGAL LIQUID CHILLERS

3.1 EQUIPMENT

Components and Their Function

Chapter 38 describes centrifugal compressors. Because they are not positive displacement, they offer a wide range of capacities continuously modulated over a limited range of pressure ratios. By altering built-in design items (e.g., number of stages, compressor speed, impeller diameters, choice of refrigerant), they can be used in liquid chillers having a wide range of design chilled-liquid temperatures and design condensing fluid temperatures. The ability to vary capacity continuously to match a wide range of load conditions with nearly proportional changes in power consumption makes a centrifugal compressor desirable for both close temperature control and energy conservation. Its ability to operate at greatly reduced capacity allows it to run most of the time with infrequent starting.

The centrifugal compressor has a minimum of bearing and other contacting surfaces that can wear; wear is also minimized by providing forced lubrication to those surfaces before start-up and during shutdown. Bearing wear usually depends more on the number of start-ups than the actual hours of operation. Thus, reducing the number of start-ups extends system life and reduces maintenance costs.

Compressors may be open or hermetic. Open compressors may be driven by steam or gas turbines or engines, or electric motors, with or without speed-increasing gears. (Engine and turbine drives are covered in Chapter 7, and electric motor drives in Chapter 45.)

Packaged electric-drive chillers may be open or hermetic and use two-pole, 50 or 60 Hz polyphase electric motors, with or without speed-increasing gears, which may be installed in a separate gearbox from the compressor. Several types of starters are commonly used with water-cooled chillers; starter selection depends on many variables, including cost, electrical system characteristics, voltage, and power company regulations at the installation. The electric drive motor can also be started with a variable-frequency drive (VFD), which provides a reduced-power start and can provide significant efficiency improvement at less than full load.

For larger chillers, starters or VFDs may be unit-mounted or remote-mounted from the chiller. The vast majority of units have unit mounting, which saves space, reduces installation costs, and increases the reliability of the chiller system. Unit-mounted starters or VFDs are predominant on centrifugal chillers because the entire chiller's electrical requirement is supplied with power through a single-point connection. Several electrical connections are required for remote-mounted starters or VFDs, and separate electrical feeds are required for the compressor, oil pump, and unit controls. These separate wiring connections must be field installed between the remote starter and the chiller.

Flooded coolers are commonly used, although direct-expansion coolers can also be used. The typical flooded cooler uses copper or copper alloy tubes that are mechanically expanded into the tube sheets, and, in some cases, into intermediate tube supports.

Because liquid refrigerant that flows into the compressor increases power consumption and may cause internal damage, mist eliminators or baffles are often used in flooded coolers to minimize refrigerant liquid entrainment in the suction gas. (Additional information on coolers for liquid chillers is found in Chapter 41.)

The condenser is generally water cooled, with refrigerant condensing on the outside of copper tubes. Large condensers may have refrigerant drain baffles, which direct refrigerant condensate from within the tube bundle directly to liquid drains, reducing the liquid film thickness on the lower tubes.

Air-cooled condensers can be used with units that use higher-pressure refrigerants, but with considerable increase in unit energy consumption at design conditions. Compare operating costs (including costs for cooling towers and condenser water pumps) for air-cooled and water-cooled condensing.

System modifications, including subcooling and economizing (described under Principles of Operation), are often used to conserve energy by enhancing the refrigeration cycle efficiency. Some units combine the condenser, cooler, and refrigerant flow control in one vessel; a subcooler may also be incorporated. (Additional information about thermodynamic cycles is in Chapter 2 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*. Chapter 39 in this volume has information on condensers and subcoolers.)

Capacities and Types Available

Centrifugal packages are available from about 280 kW to over 14 MW at nominal conditions of 7°C leaving chilled-water temperature and 35°C leaving condenser water temperature, but these limits are continually changing. Field-assembled machines extend to about 35 MW. Single- and two-stage internally geared machines and two- and three-stage direct-drive machines are commonly used in packaged units. Electric motor-driven machines constitute the majority of units sold.

Selection of Refrigerant

All refrigerants have advantages and disadvantages that must be carefully considered when choosing a refrigerant and chiller. Legislative phaseout requirements also differ, based on environmental properties [e.g., ozone depletion potential (ODP)] and direct and indirect contributions to global warming as quantified by various metrics [e.g., global warming potential (GWP), total equivalent warming impact (TEWI), life-cycle climate performance (LCCP)]. Table 1 gives some properties of example refrigerants; for details, see Chapters 29 and 30 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

Table 1 summarizes these values for various refrigerants.

Global warming is a major global environmental concern. Refrigerants contribute to the greenhouse effect both directly (e.g., from leakage into the atmosphere during operation, maintenance, or at end of life) and indirectly (from energy used to operate air-conditioning equipment). The total warming effect of a chiller should take into account both these effects.

Direct contribution to global warming is evaluated by the refrigerant's GWP and the amount of refrigerant released in the atmosphere during the life of the equipment. Indirect contribution to global warming is related to chiller efficiency: a less efficient chiller requires more power to be generated at the local power plant, and thus has a greater indirect contribution to global warming. TEWI and LCCP are two metrics used to evaluate the combined effect of direct and indirect global warming contributions.

Whereas ozone-depleting substances are addressed by the Montreal Protocol, there are no global-warming-based phaseouts currently in effect for air-conditioning refrigerants in stationary applications. However, with the increasing attention on greenhouse gases, the industry is likely moving toward refrigerants with reduced GWP values.

Safety is also an important consideration. Regardless of the refrigerant selected, refrigerant leak detectors, alarms, and emergency ventilation are now required by code in many applications. Safety classifications of refrigerants are categorized by a code, with a letter designating toxicity levels [A = occupational exposure limit (OEL) of ≥400 ppm; B = OEL of <400 ppm] and a numeral indicating flammability ranking (1 to 3, with lower numbers indicating lower flammability). For example, R-123 has a B1 classification, and R-22 and R-134a have A1 classifications, as described in ASHRAE *Standard* 34. With proper safety procedures, R-123, R-22, and R-134a are all allowed under most North American codes.

Table 1 Properties of Various Refrigerants

Refrigerant	ODP	GWP	Atmospheric Life, years	ASHRAE Classification	COP*	Evap. Pressure, kPa	Cond. Pressure, kPa
R-22	0.04	1760	12	A1	6.33	584	1355
R-134a	0.00	1300	9.7	A1	6.32	350	887
R-1234yf	0.00	<1	0.027	A2L	6.08	373	895
R-1234ze(E)	0.00	<1	0.045	A2L	6.30	259	667
R-123	0.01	79	1.3	B1	6.68	40.8	131
R-1233zd(E)	0.0003	1	0.071	A1	6.62	59.7	183

*Cycle COP and pressures evaluated at 5/35°C saturation temperatures with zero subcooling and 80% isentropic compression efficiency.

Chiller operating pressure also affects pressure vessel requirements, emissive potential, and ancillary equipment:

- Any chiller with components operating below atmospheric pressure [e.g., R-514A, R-1233zd(E)] must have a purge device to remove noncondensable gases, which may leak into the machine.
- Chillers with all components operating above atmospheric pressure (e.g., R-134a, R-513A) do not require a purge device.
- A pressure vessel code may be required, depending on design working pressure.
- A chiller's refrigerant leak potential is related to the selected refrigerant's molecular weight and saturation pressure range, coupled with the machine's hermetic integrity and installation, maintenance, and service practices. In general, all chillers have the potential for extremely low emissions. ASHRAE *Standard* 147 provides methods for design, manufacturing and operational practices to achieve low leakage rates. Typical refrigerant leakage rates vary between 0.5 to 2.0% per year.

Refrigerant stability and **material compatibility** are also important considerations in chiller design; ways to control typical contaminants must be considered, as well. Various contaminants and their control are discussed in Chapter 7 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*. Selecting elastomers and electrical insulating materials requires special attention because many of these materials are affected by refrigerants. Additional information on material selection can be found in Chapter 6 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*, and information on testing methods can be found in ASHRAE *Standard* 97.

Energy efficiency is a factor when selecting a refrigerant and chiller system. Each refrigerant discussed in this section has a different theoretical or baseline energy performance, according to its thermodynamic and thermophysical properties. Table 1 lists the theoretical COP at temperatures and pressures commonly applied in commercial comfort air-conditioning applications. From that baseline, chiller manufacturers enhance their designs to optimize refrigerant properties for the selected refrigerant. Also, some chillers are more efficient at peak load, whereas others perform better at off-peak conditions, so an accurate load model is necessary to make a fully informed choice. Chiller performances at peak and off-peak operating conditions are a function of specific chiller and compressor design, not refrigerant type. More thorough data on refrigerant properties are available in Chapters 29 and 30 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*.

For additional information on properties of refrigerants and their applications, see ASHRAE *Standards* 15 and 34.

3.2 PERFORMANCE AND OPERATING CHARACTERISTICS

Figure 9 shows a compressor's performance at constant speed with various inlet guide vane settings. Figure 10 shows a compressor's performance at various speeds in combination with inlet guide vanes. Capacity is modulated at constant speed by automatic adjustment of prerotation vanes that swirl the refrigerant gas at the impeller eye. This effect matches demand by shifting the compressor performance curve downward and to the left (as shown in Figure 9). Compressor efficiency, when unloaded in this manner, is superior to suction throttling. Some manufacturers automatically reduce diffuser width or throttle the impeller outlet with decreasing load.

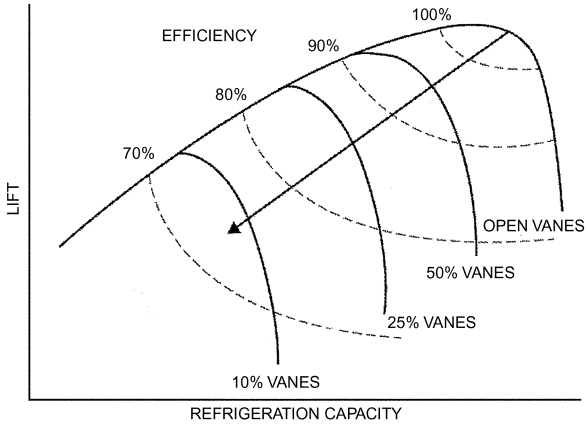

Fig. 9 Typical Centrifugal Compressor Performance at Constant Speed

(Carrier 2004)

Speed control for a centrifugal compressor offers even lower power consumption. Variable-frequency drive (VFD) control continuously reduces the compressor's capacity, keeping operation in the maximum efficiency region over a much broader range of operation. Essentially, the VFD adjusts the compressor's speed to keep the inlet guide vanes (IGVs) as open as possible to meet the system lift requirements, with the lowest power consumption. Combined with the drop in condenser water temperature that occurs naturally in an air-conditioning system, the variable-speed centrifugal compressor more efficiently meets the flow and lift condition or state point required by the system.

Although capacity is directly related to a change in speed, the lift produced is proportional to the square of the change in speed.

Hot-gas bypass allows the compressor to operate down to zero load. This feature is a particular advantage for intermittent industrial applications such as cooling quenching tanks. Bypass vapor maintains power consumption at the same level attained just before starting bypass, regardless of load reductions.

Figure 11 shows an application where condenser water decreases with load, and the resulting **temperature lift**. A typical reduction in entering condenser water temperature of 6 K helps to reduce temperature lift at low load. Other factors producing lower lift at reduced loads include the following:

- Reduced condenser cooling water range (difference between entering and leaving temperatures, resulting from decreasing heat rejection)
- Decreased temperature difference between condensing refrigerant and leaving condenser water

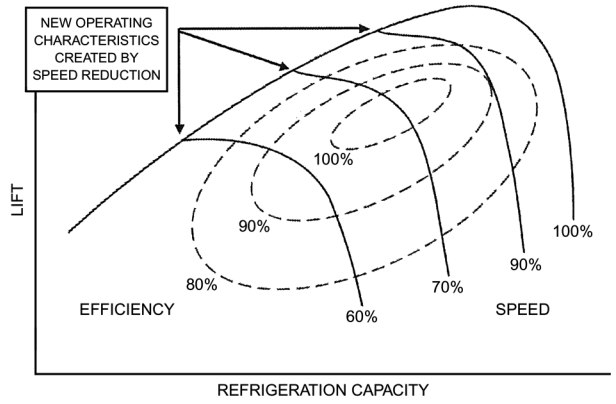

Fig. 10 Typical Variable-Speed Centrifugal Compressor Performance

(Carrier 2004)

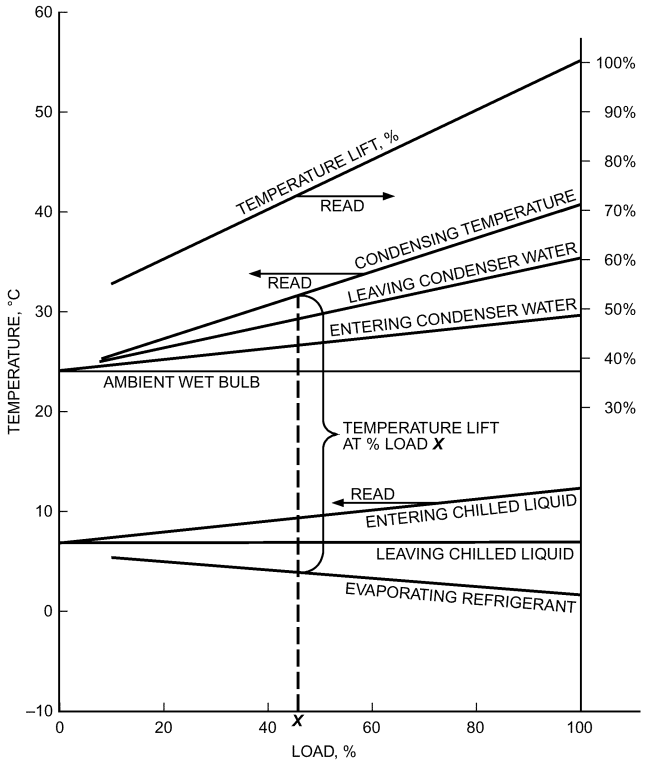

Fig. 11 Temperature Relations in a Typical Centrifugal Liquid Chiller

- Similar decrease between evaporating refrigerant and leaving chilled-liquid temperature
- Multiple chillers configured in series or series-counterflow

In applications where the wet-bulb temperature drops with cooling load, even greater decreases in entering condenser water temperature may be achieved depending on the system design.

In cooling tower applications, minimum water temperatures can be controlled by a cooling tower bypass, or for better system efficiency by cooling tower fan control as required by ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1. When optimizing the heat rejection system efficiency, the chiller, cooling tower, and pump energy should all be considered to determine the design condenser flow rate.

Surging occurs when the system-specific work becomes greater than the compressor-developed specific work or above the surge line indicated in Figures 9 and 10. Excessively high temperature lift and corresponding specific work commonly originate from

- Excessive condenser or evaporator water-side fouling beyond the specified allowance
- Inadequate cooling tower performance and higher-than-design condenser water temperature
- Noncondensable gases in the condenser, which increase condenser pressure
- Condenser flow less than design

3.3 SELECTION

Ratings

A centrifugal chiller with specified details is typically selected using a manufacturer's computer-generated selection program, many of which are AHRI certified. Capacity, unloading stability requirements, efficiency requirements, liquid flow turndown requirements, number of passes, water-side pressure drop in each of the heat exchangers, and desired electrical characteristics are input to select the chiller.

Unloading stability is important in evaluating the part-load operating condition for a centrifugal chiller. If head pressure during part-load operation is higher than the chiller was selected for, the impeller may not be able to overcome the lift, and the chiller may begin unstable operation, causing the compressor to surge. For humid regions, typical stability is chosen at approximately 50% of full load at design entering condenser water, to guard against surge conditions.

Centrifugal chillers are typically selected for full- and/or part-load coefficient of performance (COP) targets. Then they are checked for part-load stability using software provided by the chiller manufacturer. A typical part-load stability check may involve running the chiller at part-load points at entering condenser water temperatures that follow a relief profile representative of the project climate zone, building load profile, and system heat rejection design (e.g., cooling tower, dry cooler).

Most manufacturers offer variations of evaporators, condensers, tube counts, tube types, compressor gears, impellers, etc. All of these permutations create an enormous product offering that is much too difficult to fit into a tabular format. For this reason, computer programs are the norm for chiller selections and ratings because they can analyze hundreds of combinations in a very short time.

Fouling

In accordance with AHRI *Standard* 550/590, manufacturers' ratings include a condenser fouling allowance of 0.044 $(m^2 \cdot K)/kW$. (Chapter 39 has further information about fouling factors.) To reduce fouling, a minimum water velocity of about 1 m/s is recommended in condensers. Maximum water velocities exceeding 3.3 m/s are not recommended because of potential erosion problems with copper tubes.

Proper water treatment and regular tube cleaning are recommended for all liquid chillers to reduce power consumption and operating problems. Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* has water treatment information.

Continuous or daily monitoring of the quality of the condenser water is desirable. Checking the quality of the chilled liquid is also desirable. Intervals between checks become greater as the possibilities for fouling contamination become less (e.g., an annual check should be sufficient for closed-loop water-circulating systems for air conditioning). Corrective treatment is required, and periodic, usually annual, cleaning of the condenser tubes usually keeps fouling within the specified allowance. In applications

where more frequent cleaning is desirable, an online cleaning system may be economical.

Noise and Vibration

Follow the chiller manufacturer's mounting recommendations to prevent transmission or amplification of vibration to adjacent equipment or structures. Auxiliary pumps, if not connected with flexible fittings, can induce vibration of the centrifugal unit, especially if the rotational speed of the pump is nearly the same as either the compressor prime mover or the compressor. Flexible tubing becomes less flexible when it is filled with liquid under pressure and some vibration can still be transmitted. General information on noise measurement and control may be found in Chapter 8 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*, Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, and AHRI *Standard* 575.

3.4 CONTROL CONSIDERATIONS

In centrifugal systems, the **chilled-liquid temperature sensor** is usually placed in thermal contact with the leaving chilled water (leaving condenser water for heating). In electrical control systems, the electrical signal is transmitted to an electronic control module, which controls the operation of an electric motor(s) positioning the capacity-controlling inlet guide vanes. For variable-speed chillers, the electronic control module's objective is to meet the temperature set point at the lowest speed possible, with inlet guide vanes as wide open as possible without surging. A current limiter is usually included on machines with electric motors. An electrical signal from a current transformer in the compressor motor controller is sent to the electronic control module. The module receives indications of both leaving chilled-water temperature and compressor motor current. The part of the electronic control module responsive to motor current is called the current limiter. It overrides the demands of the temperature sensor.

Inlet guide vanes, independent of demands for cooling, do not open more than the position that results in the present setting of the current limiter. The chilled-liquid temperature sensor provides a signal. The controlling module receives both that signal and the motor current electrical signal and controls the positioning of the inlet guide vanes.

The **current limiter** on most machines can limit current draw during periods of high electrical demand charges. This control can be set from about 40 to 100% of full-load current. When power consumption is limited, cooling capacity is correspondingly reduced. If cooling load only requires 50% of the rated load, the current (or demand) limiter can be set at 50% without loss of cooling. By setting the limiter at 50% of full current draw, any subsequent high demand charges are prevented during pulldown after start-up. Even during periods of high cooling load, it may be desirable to limit electrical demand if a small increase in chiller liquid temperature is acceptable. If temperature continues to decrease after capacity control reaches its minimum position, a low-temperature control stops the compressor and restarts it when a rise in temperature indicates the need for cooling. Manual controls may also be provided to bypass temperature control. Capacity control is at its minimum position when the compressor starts, to provide an unloaded starting condition.

Additional operating controls are needed for appropriate operation of lubricant pumps, lubricant heaters, purge units, and refrigerant transfer units. An **anti-recycle timer** should also be included to prevent frequent motor starts. Multiple-unit applications require additional controls for capacity modulation and proper unit sequencing. (See the section on Multiple-Chiller Systems.)

Safety controls protect the unit under abnormal conditions. Safety cutouts may be required for high condenser pressure, low evaporator refrigerant temperature or pressure, low lubricant pressure, high lubricant temperature, high motor temperature, magnetic bearing overload, and high discharge temperature. Auxiliary safety circuits are usually provided on packaged chillers. At installation, the circuits are field-wired to field-installed safety devices, including auxiliary contacts on the pump motor controllers and flow switches in the chilled-water and condenser water circuits. Safety controls are usually provided in a lockout circuit, which trips out the compressor motor controller and prevents automatic restart. The controls reset automatically, but the circuit cannot be completed until a manual reset switch is operated and the safety controls return to their safe positions.

3.5 AUXILIARIES

Purge units may be required for centrifugal liquid-chilling machines to maintain system hermetic chemistry integrity and efficiency. ASHRAE *Standard* 147 requires purge units for liquid-chilling machines using refrigerants with working pressures below atmospheric pressure. If a purge unit were not used, air and moisture would accumulate in the refrigerant side. Noncondensable gases collect in the condenser during operation, reducing the heat-transfer coefficient and increasing condenser pressure as a result of both their insulating effect and their partial pressure. Compressor power consumption increases, capacity decreases, and surging may occur.

Free moisture may build up once the refrigerant becomes saturated. Acids produced by a reaction between free moisture and the refrigerant then cause internal corrosion. A purge unit prevents accumulation of noncondensable gases and ensures internal cleanliness of the chiller. However, a purge unit does not reduce the need to check for and repair leaks, which is required maintenance for any liquid chiller. Purge units may be manual or automatic, compressor operated, or compressorless. To reduce the potential for air leaks when chillers are off, chillers may be heated externally to pressurize them to atmospheric pressure.

ASHRAE *Standard* 15 requires most purge units and rupture disks to be vented outdoors. Because of environmental concerns and the increasing cost of refrigerants, high-efficiency (air-to-refrigerant) purges are available that reduce refrigerant losses during normal purging.

Lubricant coolers may be water cooled, using condenser water when the quality is satisfactory, or chilled water when a small loss in net cooling capacity is acceptable. These coolers may also be refrigerant or air cooled, eliminating the need for water piping to the cooler.

A **refrigerant transfer unit** may be provided for maintenance of centrifugal liquid chillers. The unit consists of a small reciprocating compressor with electric motor drive, a condenser (air or water cooled), a lubricant reservoir and separator, valves, and interconnecting piping. Refrigerant transfers in three steps:

1. **Gravity drain.** When the receiver is at the same level as or below the cooler, some liquid refrigerant may be transferred to the receiver by opening valves in the interconnecting piping.
2. **Pressure transfer.** By resetting valves and operating the compressor, refrigerant gas is pulled from the receiver to pressurize the cooler, forcing refrigerant liquid from the cooler to the storage receiver. If the chilled-liquid and condenser water pumps can be operated to establish a temperature difference, refrigerant migration from the warmer vessel to the colder vessel can also be used to help transfer refrigerant.
3. **Pump-out.** After the liquid refrigerant has been transferred, valve positions are changed and the compressor is operated to pump refrigerant gas from the cooler to the transfer unit condenser, which sends condensed liquid to the storage receiver. If any chilled liquid (water, brine, etc.) remains in the cooler tubes,

pump-out must be stopped before cooler pressure drops below the saturation condition corresponding to the chilled liquid's freezing point.

If the saturation temperature corresponding to cooler pressure is below the chilled-liquid freezing point when recharging, refrigerant gas from the storage receiver must be introduced until cooler pressure is above this condition. The compressor can then be operated to pressurize the receiver and move refrigerant liquid into the cooler without danger of freezing.

Water-cooled transfer unit condensers provide fast refrigerant transfer. Air-cooled condensers eliminate the need for water, but they are slower and more expensive.

3.6 SPECIAL APPLICATIONS

Free Cooling

Cooling without operating the compressor of a centrifugal liquid chiller is called free cooling. When a supply of condenser water is available at a temperature below the needed chilled-water temperature, some chillers can operate as a thermal siphon. Low-temperature condenser water condenses refrigerant, which is either drained by gravity or pumped into the evaporator. Higher-temperature chilled water causes the refrigerant to evaporate, and vapor flows back to the condenser because of the pressure difference between the evaporator and the condenser. This free-cooling accessory is limited to a fraction of the chiller design capacity, and this option is not available from all manufacturers. Free-cooling capacity depends on chiller design and the temperature difference between the desired chilled-water temperature and the condenser water temperature. Free cooling is also available external to the chiller using either direct or indirect methods, as described in Chapter 40.

Heat Recovery Systems

Any building or plant with simultaneous heating and cooling loads has the potential for a heat recovery installation.

Heat recovery systems extract heat from liquid being chilled and reject some of that heat, plus the energy of compression, to a warm-water circuit for reheat or heating. Air-conditioned spaces thus furnish heating for other spaces in the same building. During the full-cooling season, all heat must be rejected outdoors, usually by a cooling tower. During spring or fall, some heat is required indoors, while some heat extracted from air-conditioned spaces must be rejected outdoors.

Heat recovery offers a low heating cost and reduces space requirements for equipment. The control system must, however, be designed carefully to take the greatest advantage of recovered heat and to maintain proper temperature and humidity in all parts of the building. Chapter 9 covers balanced heat recovery systems.

Because cooling tower water is not satisfactory for heating coils, a separate, closed warm-water circuit with another condenser bundle or auxiliary condenser, in addition to the main water chiller condenser, must be provided. In some cases, it is economically feasible to use a standard condenser and a closed-circuit heat exchanger.

Instead of rejecting all heat extracted from the chilled liquid to a cooling tower, a separate, closed condenser cooling water circuit is heated by the condensing refrigerant for comfort heating, preheating, or reheating. Some factory packages include an extra condenser water circuit, either a double-bundle condenser or an auxiliary condenser.

A centrifugal heat recovery package is controlled as follows:

Chilled-liquid temperature is controlled by a sensor in the leaving chilled-water line signaling the capacity control device.

Hot-water temperature is controlled by a sensor in the hot-water line that modulates a cooling tower bypass valve. As the heating requirement increases, hot-water temperature drops, opening the tower bypass slightly. Less heat is rejected to the tower, condensing temperature increases, and hot-water temperature is restored as more heat is rejected to the hot-water circuit.

The hot-water temperature selected affects the installed cost of the heat recovery package, as well as on the power consumption while heating. Lower hot-water temperatures of 35 to 41°C result in a less expensive machine that uses less power. Higher temperatures require greater compressor motor output, perhaps higher-pressure condenser shells, sometimes extra compression stages, or a cascade arrangement. Installed cost of the centrifugal heat recovery machine increases as a result.

Another concern in design of a central chilled-water plant with heat recovery compressors is the relative size of cooling and heating loads. These loads should be equalized on each machine so that the compressor may operate at optimum efficiency during both full cooling and full heating seasons. When the heating requirement is considerably smaller than the cooling requirement, multiple chillers lower operating costs and allow less-expensive standard centrifugal packages to be used for the rest of the cooling requirement. In multiple packages, only one unit is designed for heat recovery and carries the full heating load.

Another consideration for heat recovery chiller systems is the potential for higher cooling energy use. A standard commercial building water chiller operates with condenser water temperatures at or below 38°C. For heat recovery to be of practical use, the condenser water may need to operate at higher temperatures, thereby increasing the chiller's energy consumption. The design engineer must examine the trade-off between higher cooling energy use versus lower heating energy use; the heat recovery chiller system may not necessarily be advantageous.

Air-Cooled System

Two types of air-cooled centrifugal systems are used. One consists of a water-cooled centrifugal package with a closed-loop condenser water circuit. Condenser water is cooled in a water/air heat exchanger. This arrangement results in higher condensing temperature and increased power consumption. In addition, winter operation requires using glycol in the condenser water circuit, which reduces the heat transfer coefficient of the unit.

The other type of unit is directly air-cooled, which eliminates the intermediate heat exchanger and condenser water pumps, resulting in lower power requirements. However, condenser and refrigerant piping must be leak free.

Because a centrifugal machine will surge if it is subjected to a pressure appreciably higher than design, the air-cooled condenser must be designed to reject the required heat. In common practice, selection of a reciprocating air-cooled machine is based on an outdoor dry-bulb temperature that will be exceeded 5% of the time. A centrifugal chiller may be unable to operate during such times because of surging, unless the chilled-water temperature is raised proportionately. Thus, the compressor impeller(s) and/or speed should be selected for the maximum dry-bulb temperature to ensure that the desired chilled-water temperature is maintained at all times. In addition, the condenser coil must be kept clean.

An air-cooled centrifugal chiller should allow the condensing temperature to fall naturally to about 21°C during colder weather. The resulting decrease in compressor power consumption is greater than that for reciprocating systems controlled by thermal expansion valves.

During winter shutdown, precautions must be taken to prevent cooler liquid freezing caused by a free cooling effect from the air-cooled condenser. A thermostatically controlled heater in the cooler, in conjunction with a low-refrigerant-pressure switch to start the chilled-liquid pumps, will protect the system.

Other Coolants

Centrifugal liquid-chilling units are most frequently used for water-chilling applications, but they are also used with secondary coolants such as calcium chloride, methylene chloride, ethylene glycol, and propylene glycol. (Chapter 31 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describes properties of secondary coolants.) Coolant properties must be considered in calculating heat transfer performance and pressure drop. Because of the greater temperature rise, higher compressor speeds and possibly more stages may be required for cooling these coolants. Compound and/or cascade systems are required for low-temperature applications.

Vapor Condensing

Many process applications condense vapors such as ammonia, chlorine, or hydrogen fluoride. Centrifugal liquid-chilling units are used for these applications.

3.7 OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE

Proper operation and maintenance are essential for reliability, longevity, and safety. Chapter 40 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* includes general information on principles, procedures, and programs for effective maintenance. The manufacturer's operation and maintenance instructions should also be consulted for specific procedures. In the United States, Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) regulations require (1) certification of service technicians, (2) a statement of minimum pressures necessary during system evacuation, and (3) definition of when a refrigerant charge must be removed before opening a system for service. All service technicians or operators maintaining systems must be familiar with these regulations.

Normal operation conditions should be established and recorded at initial start-up. Changes from these conditions can be used to signal the need for maintenance. One of the most important items is to maintain a leak-free unit.

Leaks on units operating at subatmospheric pressures allow air and moisture to enter the unit, which increases condenser pressure. Although the purge unit can remove noncondensable gases sufficiently to prevent an increase in condenser pressure, continuous entry of air and attendant moisture into the system promotes refrigerant and lubricant breakdown and corrosion. Leaks from units that operate above atmospheric pressure may release environmentally harmful refrigerants. Regulations require that annual leakage not exceed a percentage of the refrigerant charge. It is good practice, however, to find and repair all leaks.

Periodic analysis of the lubricant and refrigerant charge can also identify system contamination problems. High condenser pressure or frequent purge unit operation indicate leaks that should be corrected as soon as possible. With positive operating pressures, leaks result in loss of refrigerant and operating problems such as low evaporator pressure. A leak check should also be included in preparation for a long-term shutdown. (Chapter 7 in the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* discusses the harmful effects of air and moisture.)

Normal maintenance should include periodic lubricant and refrigerant filter changes as recommended by the manufacturer. All safety controls should be checked periodically to ensure that the unit is protected properly.

Cleaning inside tube surfaces may be required at various intervals, depending on water condition. Condenser tubes may only need annual cleaning if proper water treatment is maintained. Cooler tubes need less frequent cleaning if the chilled-water circuit is a closed loop.

If the refrigerant charge must be removed and the unit opened for service, the unit should be leak-checked, dehydrated, and evacuated properly before recharging. Chapter 8 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* has information on dehydrating, charging, and testing.

4. SCREW LIQUID CHILLERS

4.1 EQUIPMENT

Components and Their Function

Single-, twin-, and tri-screw compressors are positive-displacement machines with nearly constant flow performance. Compressors for liquid chillers can be both lubricant-injected and lubricant-injection-free. (Chapter 38 describes screw compressors in detail.)

The cooler may be flooded or direct expansion. The flooded cooler is more sensitive to freezing inside the tubes, requires more refrigerant, and the lack of suction superheat requires an alternative expansion device control, such as high-side or low-side refrigerant level control. Flooded coolers generally have better performance and the heat exchanger tubes can be cleaned. The DX cooler's suction superheat enables superheat control of the expansion device, is less likely to freeze, and higher refrigerant velocity inside the tubes returns lubricant to the lubricant system rapidly. The decision to use one or the other is based on the relative importance of these factors on a given application.

Screw coolers have the following characteristics: (1) high maximum working pressure, (2) continuous lubricant scavenging, (3) no mist eliminators (flooded coolers), and (4) distributors designed for high turndown ratios (direct-expansion coolers). A suction-gas to high-pressure liquid-refrigerant heat exchanger is sometimes incorporated into the system to provide subcooling for increased capacity, reduced likelihood of vapor generation in the liquid line upstream of the expansion device, increased suction superheat for more stable expansion device control, and potential for reduced power consumption. (For further information on coolers, see Chapter 42.)

The condenser is typically included as part of the liquid-chilling package when water cooled; however, it may be remote. Air-cooled screw liquid chilling packages are also common. When remote air-cooled or evaporative condensers are applied to liquid-chilling packages, a liquid receiver generally replaces the water-cooled condenser on the package structure. Water-cooled condensers are the cleanable shell-and-tube type (see Chapter 39).

Efficient lubricant separators are required. The types and efficiencies of these separators vary according to refrigerant and application. Field-built systems require better separation than complete factory-built systems. Ammonia applications are most stringent because no appreciable lubricant returns with suction gas from the flooded coolers normally used in ammonia applications. However, separators are available for ammonia packages, which do not require the periodic addition of lubricant customary on other ammonia systems. The types of separators used are centrifugal, demister, gravity, coalescer, and combinations of these.

Semihermetic compressor units may use a centrifugal separator as an integral part of the hermetic motor while cooling the motor with discharge gas and lubricant simultaneously. A schematic of a typical refrigeration system is shown in Figure 12.

High-lift systems, such as those with a remote air-cooled condenser, or chillers used for heating duty, along with ammonia systems with a lubricant separator on the high side may have lubricant temperatures that require a lubricant cooler. Lubricant cooler loads vary widely, depending on the refrigerant and application, but they can be substantial because lubricant injected into the compressor absorbs part of the heat of compression. Lubricant is cooled by one of the following methods:

- Water-cooled using condenser water, evaporative condenser sump water, chilled water, or a separate water- or glycol-to-air cooling loop
- Air-cooled using a lubricant-to-air heat exchanger
- Refrigerant-cooled (where lubricant cooling load is low)
- Refrigerant liquid injection into the compressor
- Condensed refrigerant liquid thermal recirculation (thermosiphon), where appropriate compressor head pressure is available

The latter two methods are the most economical both in first cost and overall operating cost because cooler maintenance and special water treatment are eliminated.

Capacities and Types Available

Screw compressor liquid chillers are most commonly available as factory-packaged units from about 100 to 2100 kW. Both open and semihermetic styles are manufactured. Packages without water-cooled condensers, with receivers, are made for use with air-cooled or evaporative condensers. Most factory-assembled liquid chilling packages use R-134a.

Additionally, compressor units, comprised of a compressor, hermetic or open motor, and lubricant separator and system, are available from 70 to 7000 kW. These are used with remote evaporators and condensers for low-, medium-, and high-evaporating-temperature applications. Condensing units, similar to compressor units in range and capacity but with water-cooled condensers, are also built. Similar open motor-drive units are available for ammonia, as are booster units.

Selection of Refrigerant

The refrigerants most commonly used with screw compressors on liquid chiller applications are R-134a and R-717. R-513A and R-515B are increasing in use as lower-GWP refrigerant replacements for R-134a.

4.2 PERFORMANCE AND OPERATING CHARACTERISTICS

Figure 6 compares screw compressor operating characteristics with those for scroll/reciprocating and centrifugal compressors. Because the screw compressor is a positive-displacement compressor, it does not surge. Additionally, because it has no clearance volume in the compression chamber, it pumps high-volumetric flows at high pressure lift. Consequently, screw compressor chillers suffer the least capacity reduction at high condensing temperatures.

The screw compressor provides stable operation across its operating envelope because it is a positive-displacement machine. The operating range is wide because discharge temperature is kept low and thus is not a limiting factor due to the lubricant injection into the compression chamber. Consequently, the compressor is able to operate single-stage at high pressure ratios.

An economizer heat exchanger can be installed to improve capacity and lower power consumption at full- and part-load operation. An example is shown in Figure 12, where the main refrigerant liquid flow leaving the condenser is split, with flow to the main expansion device being subcooled in a heat exchanger via evaporation of refrigerant at mid-stage pressure that is connected to the intermediate-pressure port in the compressor. The evaporating pressure in this heat exchanger is higher than the suction pressure of the compressor.

Lubricant separators must be sized for the compressor size, type of system (factory assembled or field connected), refrigerant, and type of cooler. Direct-expansion coolers have less stringent separation requirements than do flooded coolers. In a direct-expansion system, refrigerant evaporates in the tubes, which means that velocity is kept sufficiently high that lubricant rapidly returns to the compressor. In a flooded evaporator, the refrigerant is outside the tubes, and an external lubricant-return device must be used to minimize the concentration of lubricant in the cooler, or a lubricant separator must be included with very low oil circulation. Discharge check valves are used to minimize backflow and lubricant loss during shutdown, and prevent screw reverse rotation, which can impact reliability in some applications.

Because the lubricant in systems with a high-side lubricant sump is exposed to the high-pressure side of the unit, precautions must be taken to prevent lubricant dilution. Dilution can also be caused by excessive floodback through the suction or intermediate ports, which decreases discharge superheat and results in high refrigerant concentration in the lubricant. Unless properly monitored, it may go unnoticed until serious operating or mechanical problems are experienced.

4.3 SELECTION

Ratings

Screw liquid chiller ratings are generally presented similarly to those for centrifugal chiller ratings. Tabular values include capacity and power consumption at various chilled-water and condenser water temperatures. In addition, ratings are given for packages without the condenser that list capacity and power versus chilled-water

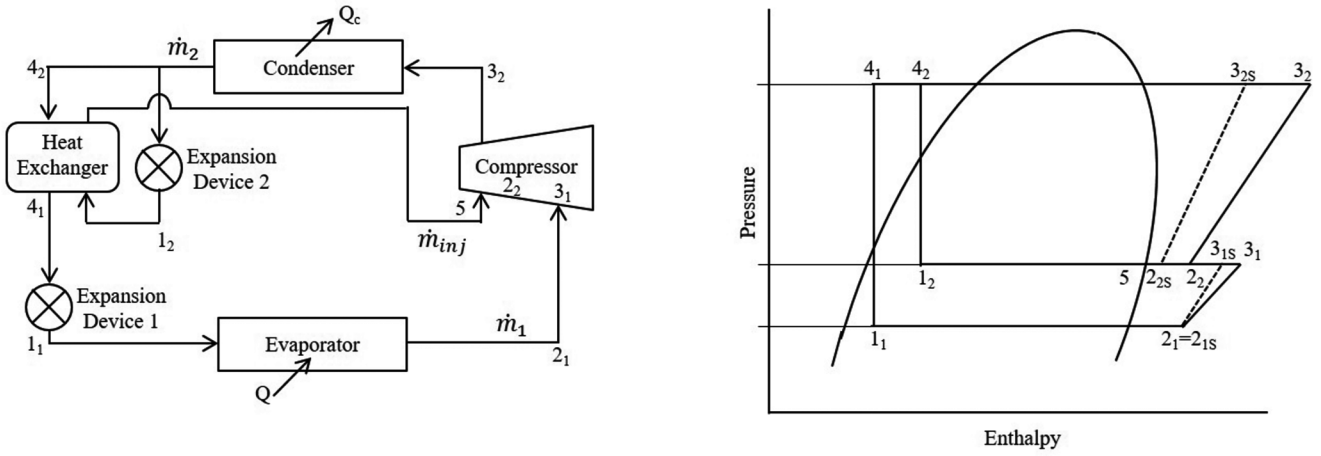

Fig. 12 Refrigeration System Schematic

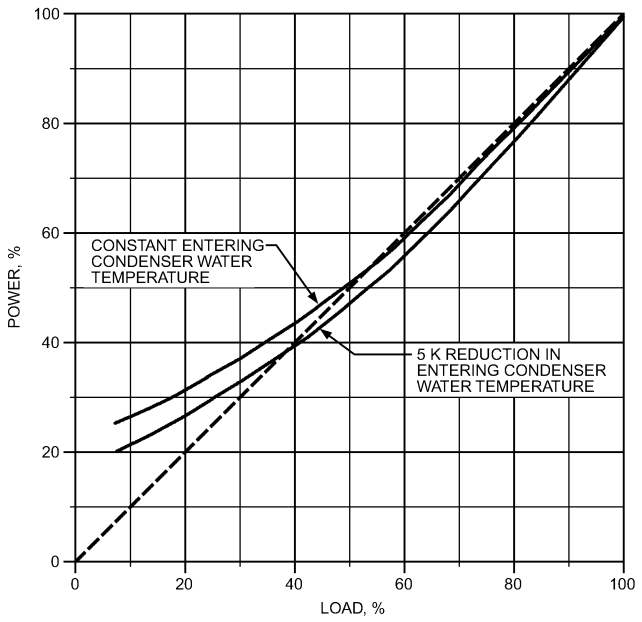

Fig. 13 Typical Screw Compressor Chiller Part-Load Power Consumption

temperature and condensing temperature. Ratings for compressors alone are also common, showing capacity and power consumption versus suction saturation temperature and condensing saturation temperature for a given refrigerant.

Power Consumption

Typical part-load power consumption is shown in Figure 13. Power consumption of screw chillers benefits from reducing condensing water temperature as the load decreases, as well as operating at the lowest practical pressure at full load. However, because direct-expansion systems require a pressure differential, the power consumption saving is not as great at part load, as shown.

Fouling

A fouling allowance of 0.044 $(m^2 \cdot K)/kW$ is incorporated in screw compressor chiller ratings. Excessive fouling (above design value) increases power consumption and reduces capacity. Fouling water-cooled lubricant coolers results in higher than desirable lubricant temperatures.

4.4 CONTROL CONSIDERATIONS

Screw chillers with slide valve and/or variable-speed unloading provide continuous capacity modulation, from 100% capacity down to 10% or less. The leaving chilled-liquid temperature is sensed for capacity control. Safety controls commonly required are (1) lubricant failure switch, (2) high-discharge-pressure cutout, (3) low-suction-pressure switch, (4) cooler flow switch, (5) high-lubricant- and discharge-temperature cutout, (6) hermetic motor inherent protection, (7) lubricant pump and compressor motor overloads, and (8) low-lubricant-temperature (floodback/dilution) protection. The compressor is unloaded automatically (slide valve driven to minimum position) before starting. Once it starts operating, the slide valve is controlled hydraulically by a temperature-load controller that energizes the load and unloads solenoid valves.

The current limit relay protects against motor overload from higher than normal condensing temperatures or low voltage, and also allows a demand limit to be set. An antirecycle timer is used to prevent overly frequent recycling. Lubricant sump heaters are energized during the off cycle. A hot-gas-capacity control is optionally available and prevents automatic recycling at no-load conditions such as is often required in process liquid chilling. A suction-to-discharge starting bypass sometimes aids starting and allows use of standard starting torque motors.

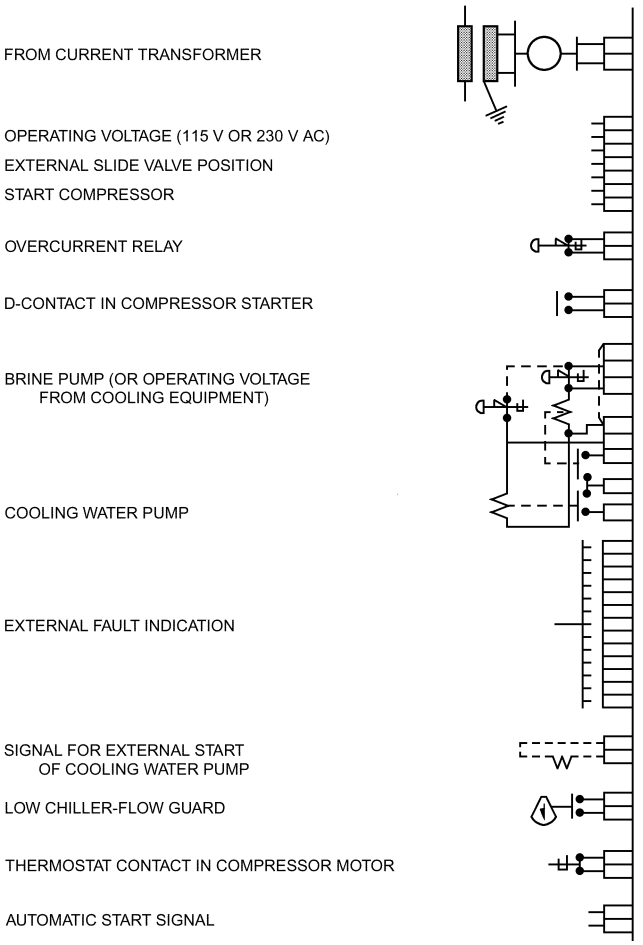

Fig. 14 Typical External Connections for Screw Compressor Chiller

Some units are equipped with electronic regulators specially developed for screw compressor characteristics. These regulators include proportional-integrating (PI) control of leaving brine temperature and functions such as automatic/manual control, capacity indication, time circuits to prevent frequent recycling and to bypass the lubricant pressure cutout during start-up, switch for unloaded starting, etc. (Typical external connections are shown in Figure 14.)

4.5 AUXILIARIES

A **refrigerant transfer unit** is similar to the unit described in the section on Auxiliaries under Centrifugal Liquid Chillers, and is designed for an appropriate operating pressure. Its flexibility is increased by including a reversible liquid pump on the unit. It is available as a portable unit or mounted on a storage receiver.

A **lubricant-charging pump** is useful for adding lubricant to the pressurized lubricant sump. Two types are used: a manual pump and an electric motor-driven positive-displacement pump.

Acoustical enclosures are available for installations that require low noise levels.

4.6 SPECIAL APPLICATIONS

Because of the screw compressor's positive-displacement characteristic and lubricant-injected cooling, its use for high-pressure-differential applications is limited only by power considerations and maximum design working pressures. Therefore, it is used for many special applications because of reasonable compressor cost and no surge characteristic. Some of the fastest-growing areas include the following:

- Heat recovery installations
- Air-cooled split packages with field-installed interconnecting piping, and factory-built rooftop packages
- Low-temperature brine chillers for process cooling
- Ice rink chillers
- Power transmission line lubricant cooling

High-temperature compressor and condensing units are used increasingly for air conditioning because of the higher efficiency of direct air-to-refrigerant heat exchange resulting in higher evaporating temperatures. Many of these installations have air-cooled condensers.

4.7 MAINTENANCE

Manufacturer's maintenance instructions should be followed, especially because some items differ substantially from reciprocating or centrifugal units. Water-cooled condensers must be cleaned of scale periodically (see the section on General Maintenance). If condenser water is also used for the lubricant cooler, this should be considered in the treatment program. Lubricant coolers operate at higher temperatures and lower flows than condensers, so it is possible that the lubricant cooler may have to be serviced more often than the condenser.

Because large lubricant flows are a part of the screw compressor system, monitor the lubricant filter pressure drop carefully and change the elements periodically. This is particularly important in the first month or so after start-up of any factory-built package, and is essential on field-erected systems. Because the lubricant and refrigeration systems merge at the compressor, loose dirt and fine contaminants in the system eventually find their way to the lubricant sump, where they are removed by the lubricant filter. Similarly, monitor the filter-drier cartridges for pressure drop and moisture during initial start and regularly thereafter. Generally, if a system reaches acceptable dryness, it stays that way unless it is opened.

It is good practice to check the lubricant for acidity periodically, using commercially available acid test kits. Lubricant does not need to be changed unless it is contaminated by water, acid, or metallic particles. Also, a refrigerant sample should be analyzed yearly to determine its condition.

Yearly or during a regularly scheduled shutdown, (1) check and calibrate all operation and safety controls, (2) tighten all electrical connections, (3) inspect power contacts in starters, (4) dielectrically check hermetic and open motors, and (5) check the alignment of open motors.

Regularly perform leak testing of the unit. A water-cooled package used for summer cooling should be leak tested annually. A flooded unit with proportionately more refrigerant in it, used for year-round cooling, should be tested every four to six months. A process air-cooled chiller designed for year-round operation 24 h per day should be checked every one to three months.

Based on 6000 operating hours per year and depending on the preceding considerations, a typical inspection or replacement timetable is as follows:

Shaft seals	1.5 to 4 yr	Inspect
Hydraulic cylinder seals	1.5 to 4 yr	Replace
Thrust bearings	4 to 6 yr	Check preload via shaft end play every 6 months and replace as required
Shaft bearings	7 to 10 yr	Inspect

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ONLINE RESOURCE

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CHAPTER 44

CENTRIFUGAL PUMPS

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CENTRIFUGAL pumps provide the primary force to distribute and recirculate hot and chilled water in a variety of space-conditioning and plumbing systems. The pump provides a predetermined flow of water to the space load terminal units or to a thermal storage chamber for release at peak loads. The effect of centrifugal pump performance on the application, control, and operation of various terminal units is discussed in Chapter 13. Other hydronic systems that use pumps include (1) condensing water circuits to cooling towers (Chapters 14 and 40), (2) water-source heat pumps (Chapter 9), (3) boiler feeds, and (4) condensate returns (Chapter 11). Boiler feed and condensate return pumps for steam boilers should be selected based on boiler manufacturer's requirements. Centrifugal pumps can also be found in water treatment and service water-heating systems.

1. CENTRIFUGAL PUMPING

In a centrifugal pump, an electric motor or other power source rotates the impeller at the motor's rated speed. Impeller rotation adds energy to the fluid after it is directed into the center or eye of the rotating impeller. The fluid is then acted on by centrifugal force and rotational or tip-speed force, as shown in the vector diagram in Figure 1. These two forces result in increased fluid velocity. The pump casing is designed for maximum conversion of velocity energy of the fluid into pressure energy, either by the uniformly increasing area of the volute or by diffuser guide vanes (when provided).

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.1, Hydronic and Steam Equipment and Systems.

2. CONSTRUCTION FEATURES

The construction features of a typical centrifugal pump are shown in Figure 2. These features vary according to manufacturer and type of pump.

Materials. Centrifugal pumps are generally available in stainless steel-fitted, bronze-fitted, or iron-fitted construction. The choice of material depends on those parts in contact with the liquid being pumped. The term "fitted" refers to the materials of impeller and wear rings (if used) and the shaft sleeve. The casing is typically cast iron. Stainless steel-fitted, bronze-fitted, and iron-fitted constructions are all appropriate for general water applications. All-bronze construction is often used in potable water applications.

Mechanical seals are devices that prevent fluid leakage along rotating shafts. They are used predominantly in clean hydronic applications, either as unbalanced or balanced (for higher pressures) seals. Balanced seals are used for high-pressure applications, particulate-laden liquids, or for extended seal life at lower pressures. Inside seals operate inside the mechanical seal chamber, whereas outside seals have the rotating element outside the box. Pressure and temperature limitations vary with the liquid pumped and the style of seal.

Shaft sleeves protect the motor or pump shaft.

Wear rings (if present) prevent wear to the impeller and/or casing and are easily replaced when worn. Using wear rings is optional, because improved casting abilities and part tolerances have reduced the need for them. Wear rings are intended for applications with abrasive solutions, which are not typical in HVAC systems.

Ball bearings are most frequently used, except in low-pressure circulators, where motor and pump bearings are the sleeve type.

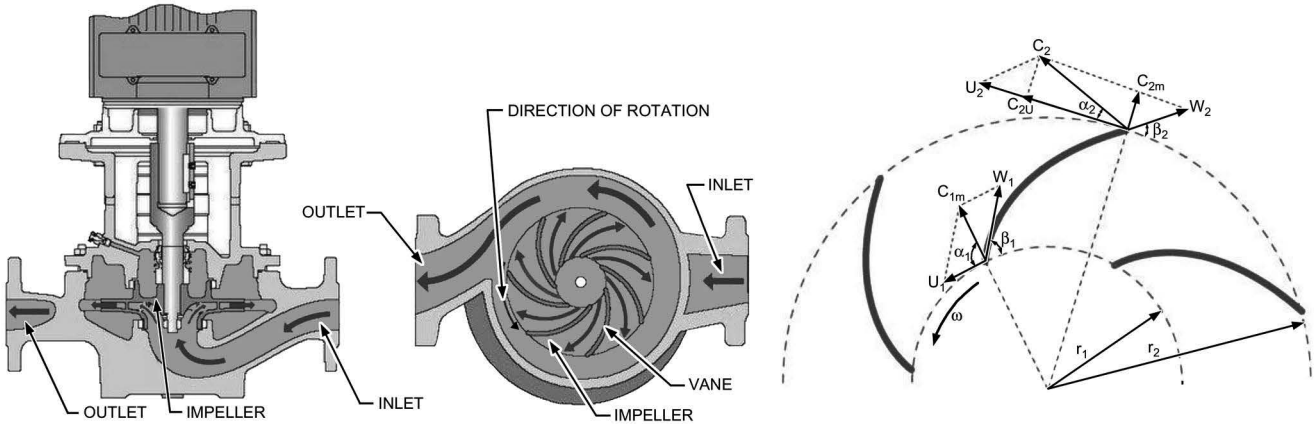

Fig. 1 Centrifugal Pump

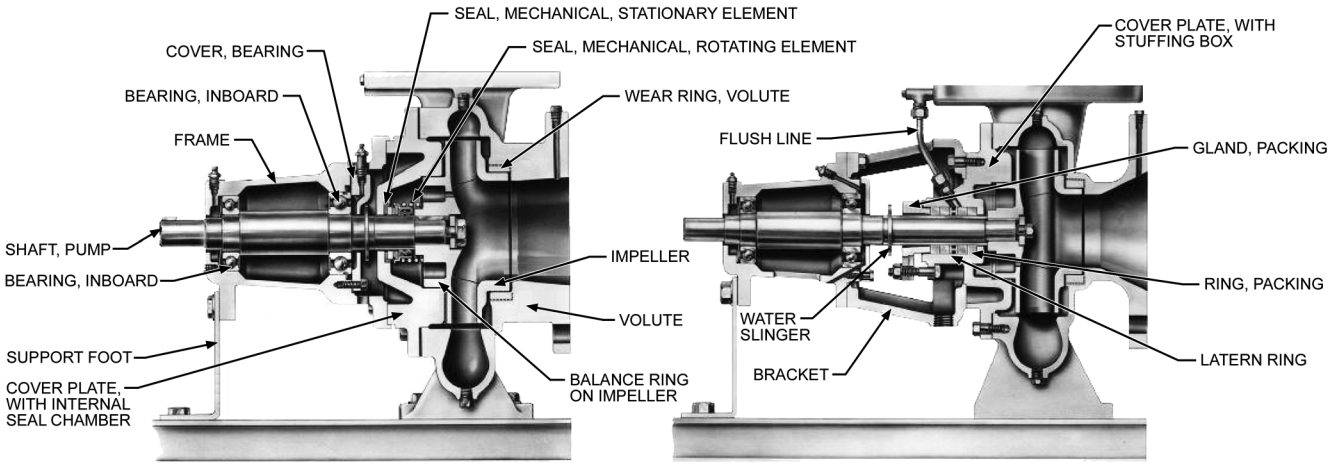

Fig. 2 Cross Section of Typical Overhung-Impeller End-Suction Pump

A **balance ring** placed on the back of a single-inlet enclosed impeller reduces the axial load, thereby decreasing the size of the thrust bearing and shaft.

Normal operating speeds of motors are 600 to 3600 rpm. The pump manufacturer can help determine the optimum pump speed for a specific application by considering pump efficiency, the available pressure at the inlet to prevent cavitation, maintenance requirements, and operating cost.

3. PUMP TYPES

Centrifugal pumps used in hydronic systems are single stage or multistage. (These terms refer to the number of impellers in the pump housing.)

A centrifugal pump has either a volute or diffuser casing. Pumps with volute casings collect water from the impeller and discharge it perpendicular to the pump shaft. Casings with diffusers discharge water parallel to the pump shaft. All pumps described in this chapter have volute casings except the vertical turbine pump, which has a diffuser casing.

Pumps may be classified as close-coupled or flexible-coupled to the electric motor. The close-coupled pump has the impeller mounted on a motor shaft extension, and the flexible-coupled pump has an impeller shaft supported by a frame or bracket that is connected to the electric motor through a flexible coupling.

Pumps may also be classified by their mechanical features and installation arrangement. Close-coupled pumps have an end-suction inlet for horizontal mounting or a vertical in-line inlet for direct installation in the piping. Base-mounted pumps are (1) end-suction, frame-mounted or (2) double-suction, horizontal or vertical split-case units. Double-suction pumps can also be arranged vertically on a support frame with the motor vertically mounted on a bracket above the pump. Pumps are usually labeled by their mounting position as either horizontal or vertical.

Circulator Pump

A circulator pump is a low-pressure, low-capacity, in-line centrifugal pump, with or without an electric motor, consisting of an in-line casing that houses one impeller, which is intended for pipe-mounted installation in heating systems or cooling distribution systems. This pump may have a wet rotor (Figure 3) or may be driven by a close-coupled (Figure 4) or flexible-coupled motor (Figure 5). Circulator pumps are commonly used in residential and commercial buildings to circulate source water and to recirculate the flow of terminal coils to enhance heat transfer and improve the control of large systems.

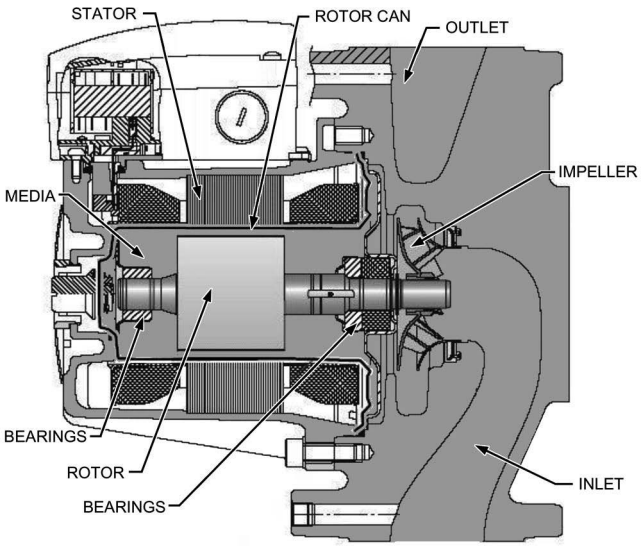

Fig. 3 Wet-Rotor Circulator Pump

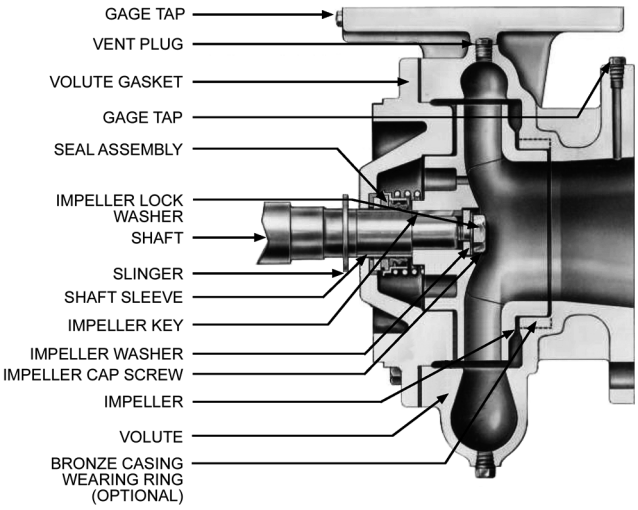

Fig. 4 Circulator Driven by Close-Coupled Motor

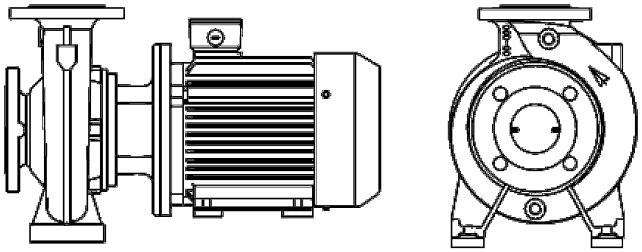

Fig. 5 Close-Coupled Single-Stage End-Suction Pump

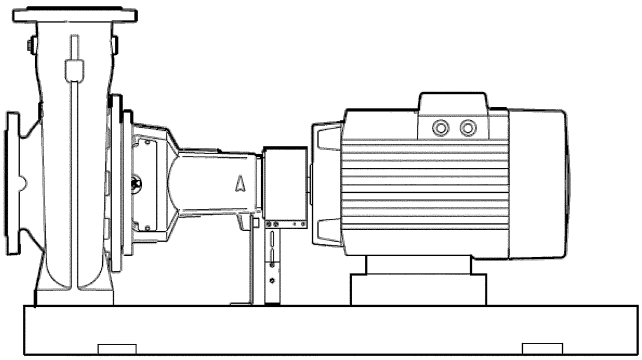

Fig. 6 Frame-Mounted End-Suction Pump on Base Plate

Close-Coupled, Single-Stage, End-Suction Pump

The close-coupled pump is mounted on a horizontal motor supported by the motor or pump foot mountings (Figure 5). Mounting usually requires a solid concrete pad. The impeller is directly mounted on the motor shaft, eliminating the need for flexible couplings. This compact pump has a single horizontal inlet and vertical discharge. It may have one or two impellers.

Frame-Mounted, End-Suction Pump on Base Plate

Typically, the motor and pump are mounted on a common, rigid base plate for horizontal mounting (Figure 6). Mounting requires a solid concrete pad. The motor is flexible-coupled to the pump shaft and should have an Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA)-approved guard. For horizontal mounting, the piping is horizontal on the suction side and vertical on the discharge side. This pump has a single suction.

Base-Mounted, Horizontal (Axial) or Vertical, Split-Case, Single-Stage, Double-Suction Pump

The motor and pump are mounted on a common, rigid base plate for horizontal mounting (Figures 7 and 8). Axial pumps can be vertically mounted with a vertical pump casing and motor mounting bracket with open seal chamber design (see Figure 9). Mounting requires a solid concrete pad and rigid steel base plate, which may or may not require grouting. The motor is flexible-coupled to the pump shaft, and the coupling should have an OSHA-approved guard; a spacer coupling allows for removal of the pump's rotating element without disturbing the pump volute or movement of the pump's motor and electrical connections. A split case allows complete access to the impeller for maintenance. This pump may have one or two double-suction impellers.

Base-Mounted, Horizontal, Split-Case, Multistage Pump

The motor and pump are mounted on a common, rigid base plate for horizontal mounting (Figure 9). Mounting requires a solid concrete pad. The motor is flexible-coupled to the pump shaft, and the coupling should have an OSHA-approved guard. Piping is horizontal

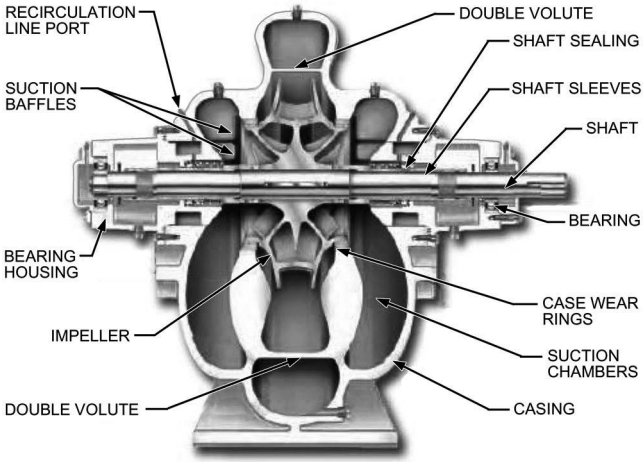

Fig. 7 Base-Mounted, Horizontal (Axial), Split-Case, Single-Stage, Double-Suction Pump

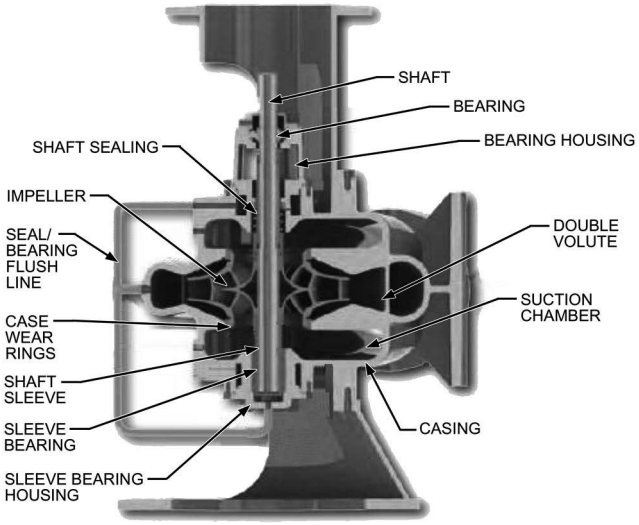

Fig. 8 Base-Mounted, Vertical, Split-Case, Single-Stage, Double-Suction Pump

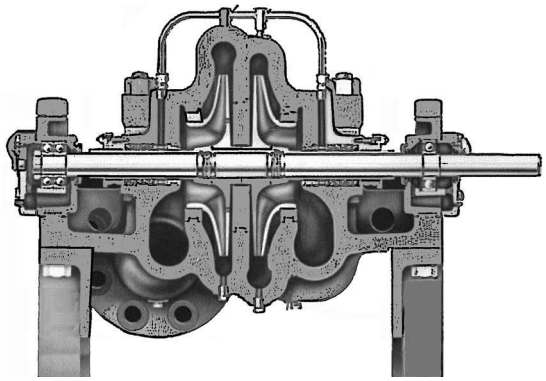

Fig. 9 Base-Mounted, Horizontal, Split-Case, Multistage Pump

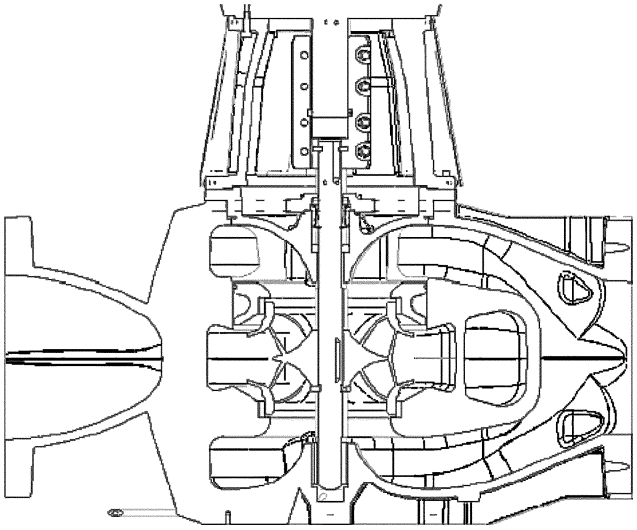

Fig. 10 Vertical In-Line Split-Coupled Pump (Double Suction Impeller)

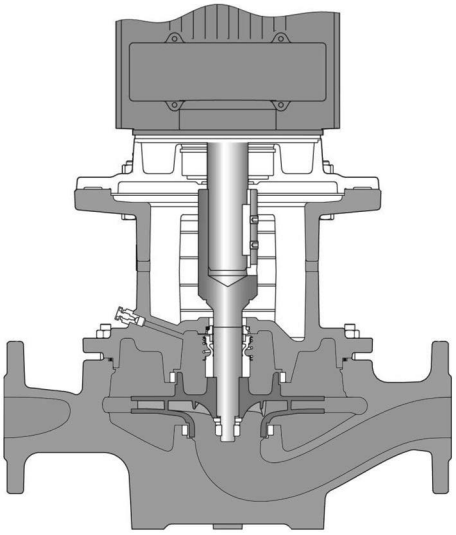

Fig. 11 Vertical In-Line Pump (Single Suction Impeller)

on both the suction and discharge sides. The split case allows complete access to the impellers for maintenance. This pump has a single suction and may have one or more impellers for multistage operation.

Vertical In-Line Pump

This close-coupled pump and motor are mounted on the pump casing. The unit is compact and depends on the connected piping for support. Mounting requires adequately spaced pipe hangers and, sometimes, a vertical casing support. The suction and discharge piping is horizontal. The pump has a single or double suction impeller.

Vertical In-Line Split-Coupled Pump

The suction and discharge flanges of this pump are oriented in the horizontal plane, on a common centerline. The motor is installed vertically. The pump has an overhung impeller and a rigid coupler. This design uses bushings but no bearing frame. The impeller is held in alignment by the motor bearings, rigid coupling, and bushing. The coupler is a spacer design with a gap between the motor shaft and pump shaft that is wider than the mechanical seal height. Removing the coupler allows access to replace the mechanical seal between the motor shaft and pump shaft without moving the motor. This pump can be either single or double suction (see Figures 10 and 11). Large double-suction pumps may have a bushing in the bottom of the volute to keep the pump shaft centered.

Vertical Turbine, Single- or Multistage, Sump-Mounted Pump

Vertical turbine pumps have a motor mounted vertically on the pump discharge head for either wet-sump or can-type mounting (Figure 12). This single-suction pump may have one or multiple impellers for multistage operation. Mounting requires a solid concrete pad or steel sole plate above the wet pit with accessibility to the screens or trash rack on the suction side for maintenance. Can-type mounting requires a suction strainer. Piping is horizontal on the discharge side and on the suction side. The sump should be designed according to Hydraulic Institute (HI) recommendations.

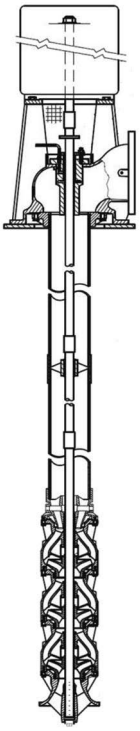

Fig. 12 Vertical Turbine Pump

4. PUMP PERFORMANCE CURVES

Performance of a centrifugal pump is commonly shown by a manufacturer's performance curve (Figure 13). The figure displays the pump power required for a liquid (water) with a density of 1000 kg/m^3 over a particular range of impeller diameters and flows. The curves are based on standard test procedures developed by the Hydraulic Institute (2008-2010) and the International Organization for Standardization (ISO). The tests are performed by the manufacturer for a given pump volute or casing and several impeller diameters, normally from the maximum to the minimum allowable in that volute. The tests are conducted at a constant impeller speed for various flows.

Pump curves represent the average results from testing several pumps of identical design under the same conditions. The discharge

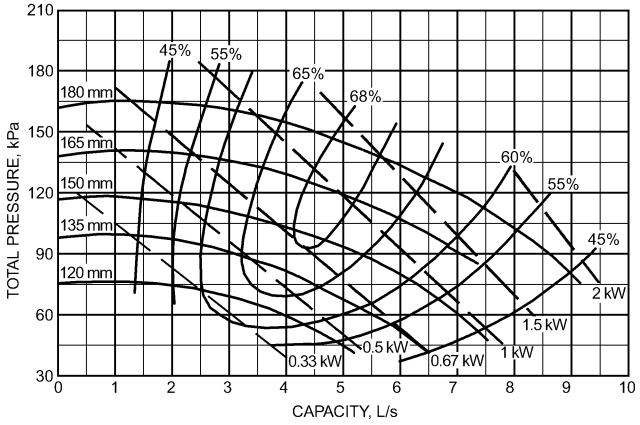

Fig. 13 Typical Pump Performance Curve

Fig. 14 Typical Pump Curve

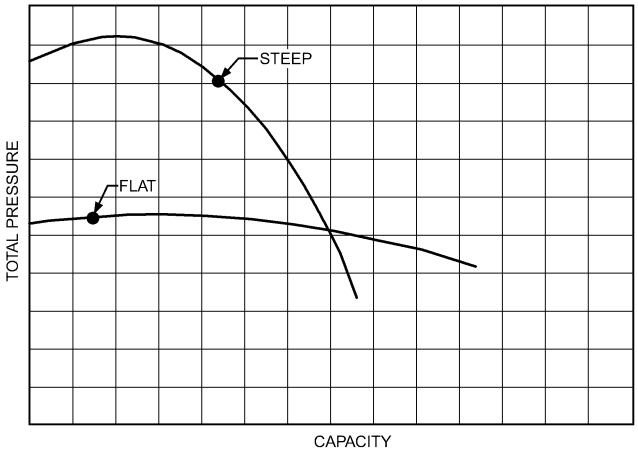

Fig. 15 Flat Versus Steep Performance Curves

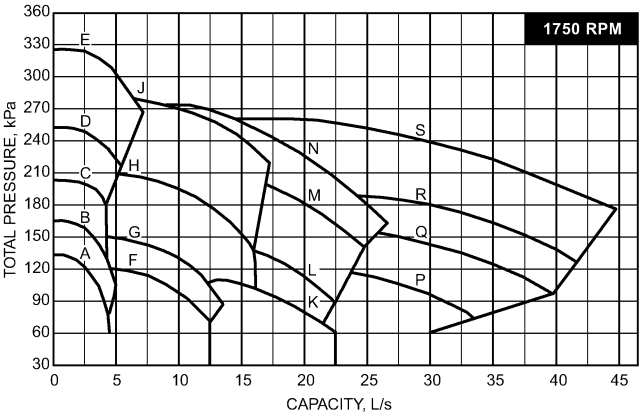

Fig. 16 Typical Pump Manufacturer's Performance Curve Series

pressure decreases as the flow increases (Figure 14). Motors are often selected to be non-overloading at a specified impeller size and maximum flow to ensure safe motor operation at all flow requirements.

The pump characteristic curve may be further described as flat or steep (Figure 15). Sometimes these curves are described as a normal rising curve (flat), a drooping curve (steep), or a steeply rising curve. The pump curve is considered flat if the pressure at shutoff is about 1.10 to 1.20 times the pressure at the best efficiency point. Flat characteristic pumps are usually installed in closed systems with modulating two-way control valves. Steep characteristic pumps are usually installed in open systems, such as cooling towers (see Chapter 14), where higher pressure and constant flow are usually desired.

Pump manufacturers may compile performance curves for a particular set of pump volutes in a series (Figure 16). The individual curves are shown in the form of an envelope consisting of the maximum and minimum impeller diameters and the ends of their curves. This set of curves is known as a family of curves. A family of curves is useful in determining the approximate size and model required, but the particular pump curve (Figure 13) must then be used to confirm an accurate selection.

Many pump manufacturers and HVAC software suppliers offer electronic versions for pump selection. Pump selection software typically allows the investigation of different types of pumps and operating parameters. Corrections for fluid density, temperature, and motor speeds are easily performed.

5. HYDRONIC SYSTEM CURVES

Pressure drop caused by the friction of a fluid flowing in a pipe may be described by the Darcy-Weisbach equation:

$$\Delta p = f \frac{L}{D} \rho \frac{V^2}{2} \tag{1}$$

Equation (1) shows that pressure drop in a hydronic system (pipe, fittings, and equipment) is proportional to the square of the flow (V^2 or Q^2 where Q is the flow). Experiments show that pressure drop is more nearly proportional to between $V^{1.85}$ and $V^{1.9}$, or a nearly parabolic curve as shown in Figures 17 and 20. The design of the system (including the number of terminals and flows, the fittings and valves, and the length of pipe mains and branches) affects the shape of this curve.

Equation (1) may also be expressed in specific energy form:

$$\Delta h = \frac{\Delta p}{\rho g} = f \frac{L}{D} \frac{V^2}{2g} \tag{2}$$

where

Δh = loss through friction, m (of fluid flowing)

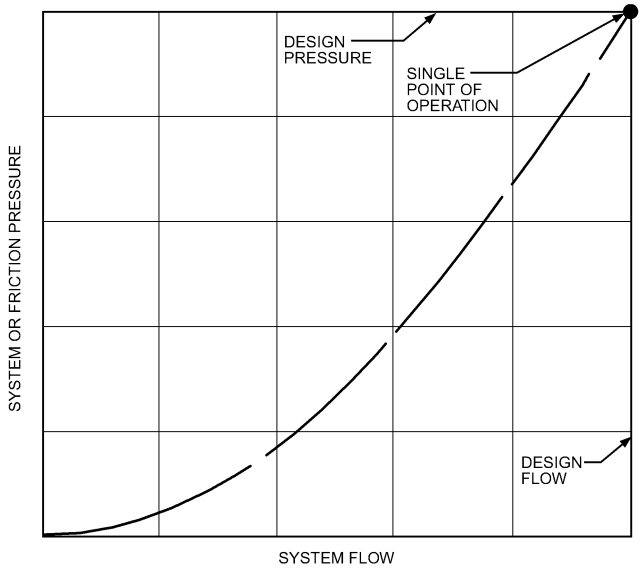

Fig. 17 Typical System Curve

Δp = pressure drop, Pa
ρ = fluid density, kg/m^3
f = friction factor, dimensionless
L = pipe length, m
D = inside diameter of pipe, m
V = fluid average velocity, m/s
g = gravitational acceleration, 9.8 m/s^2

The system curve (Figure 17) defines the system pressure required to produce a given flow rate for a liquid and its characteristics in a piping system design. To produce a given flow, the system pressure must overcome pipe friction, inside pipe surface roughness, actual fitting losses, actual valve losses, resistance to flow due to fluid viscosity, and possible system effect losses. The general shape of this curve is parabolic because, according to the Darcy-Weisbach equation (Equation [2]), the pressure loss is proportional to the square of the flow.

If static pressure is present because of the height of the liquid in the system or the pressure in a compression tank, this static is added to the system curve (Figure 18).

6. PUMP AND HYDRONIC SYSTEM CURVES

The pump curve and the system curve can be plotted on the same graph. The intersection of the two curves (Figure 19) is the system **operating point**, where the pump's developed pressure matches the system's pressure loss.

In a typical hydronic system, a thermostat or controller varies the flow in a load terminal by positioning a two-way control valve to match the load. At full load the two-way valves are wide open, and the system follows curve A in Figure 20. As the load drops, the terminal valves begin closing to match the load (part load). This increases the friction and reduces the flow in the terminals. The system curve gradually changes to curve B.

The operating point of a pump should be considered when the system includes two-way control valves. Point 1 in Figure 21 shows the pump operating at the design flow at the calculated design pressure loss of the system. But typically, the actual system curve is slightly different from the design curve. As a result, the pump operates at point 2 and produces a flow rate higher than design.

To reduce the actual flow to the design flow at point 1, a balancing valve downstream from the pump can be adjusted while all the terminal valves are in a wide-open position. This pump discharge

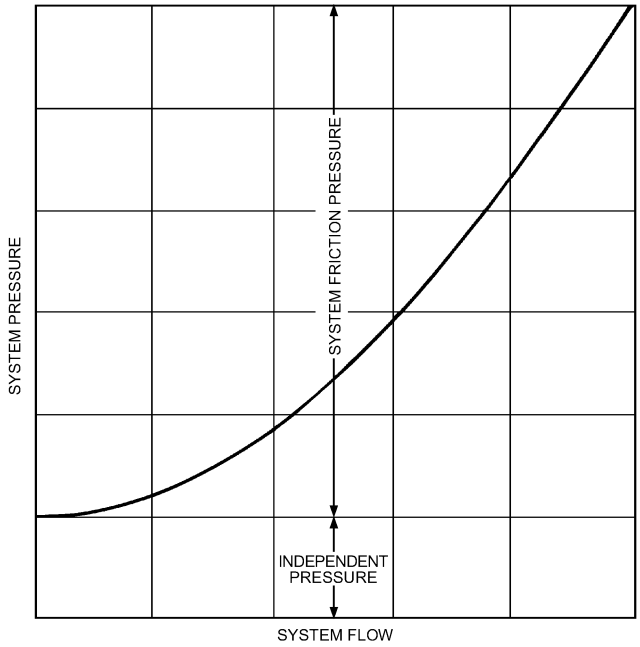

Fig. 18 Typical System Curve with Independent Pressure

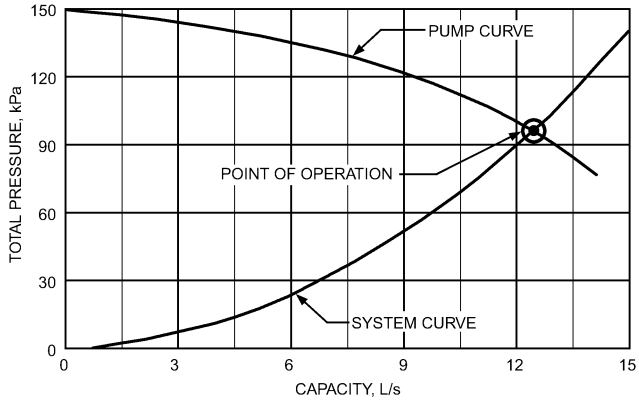

Fig. 19 System and Pump Curves

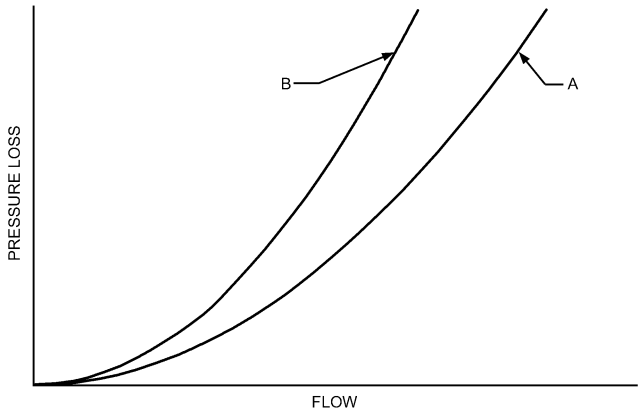

Fig. 20 System Curve Change due to Part-Load Flow

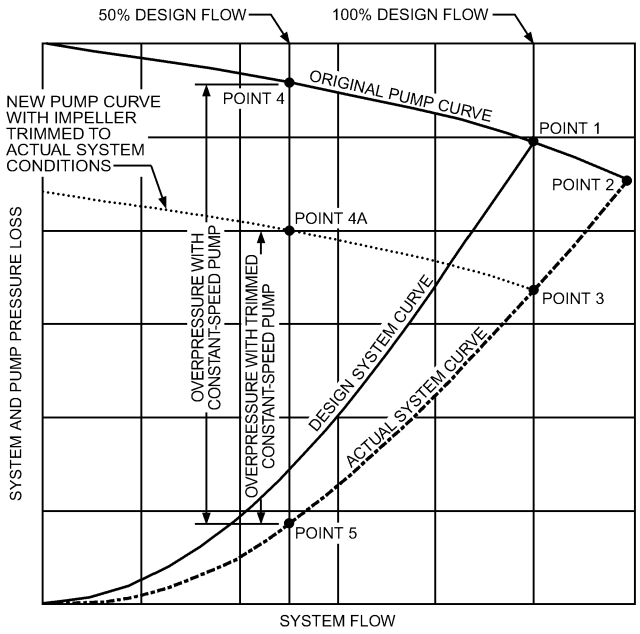

Fig. 21 Pump Operating Points

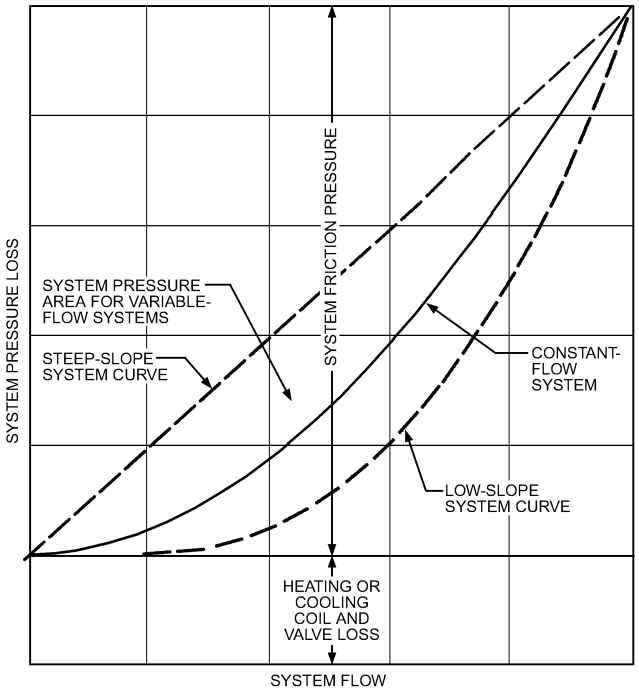

Fig. 22 System Curve, Constant and Variable Pressure Loss

balancing valve imposes a pressure drop equal to the pressure difference between point 1 and point 3. The manufacturer's pump curve shows that the capacity may be reduced by substituting a new impeller with a smaller diameter or by trimming the existing pump impeller. After trimming, reopening the balancing valve in the pump discharge then eliminates the artificial drop and the pump operates at point 3. Points 3 and 4A demonstrate the effect a trimmed impeller has on reducing flow.

Figure 22 is an example of a system curve with both static pressure loss and variable pressure loss. Such a system might be an open

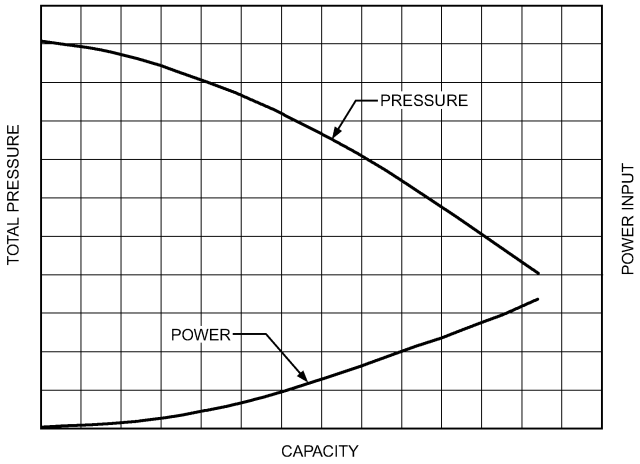

Fig. 23 Typical Pump Water Power Increase with Flow

piping circuit between a refrigerating plant condenser and its cooling tower. The elevation difference between the water level in the tower pan and the spray distribution pipe creates the static pressure loss. The static loss occurs at all flow rates.

Most variable-flow hydronic systems have individual two-way control valves on each terminal unit to allow full diversity (random loading from zero to full load). Regardless of the load required in most variable-flow systems, the designer establishes a minimum pressure difference to ensure that any terminal and its control valve receive the design flow at full demand.

The low slope and steep slope curves in Figure 22 represent the boundaries for operation of the system. The net vertical difference between the curves is the difference in friction loss developed by the distribution mains for the two extremes of possible loads. The area in which the system operates depends on the diverse loading or unloading imposed by the terminal units. This area represents the pumping energy that can be conserved with one-speed, two-speed, or variable-speed pumps after a review of the pump power, efficiency, and affinity relationships.

7. PUMP POWER

The theoretical power to circulate water in a hydronic system is the **water power P_w** and is calculated as follows:

$$P_w = \dot{m}\ \Delta p/\rho \tag{3}$$

where

$\dot{m}$ = mass flow of fluid, kg/s
Δp = pressure increase, Pa

Figure 23 shows how water power increases with flow.

The total power P_t required to operate the pump is determined by the manufacturer's test of an actual pump running under standard conditions to produce the required flow and pressure as shown in Figure 13.

8. PUMP EFFICIENCY

Pump efficiency is determined by comparing the output power to the input power:

$$\text{Efficiency} = \frac{\text{Output}}{\text{Input}} = \frac{P_w}{P_t} \times 100\% \tag{4}$$

Figure 24 shows a typical efficiency versus flow curve.

The pump manufacturer usually plots the efficiencies for a given volute and impeller size on the pump curve to help the designer

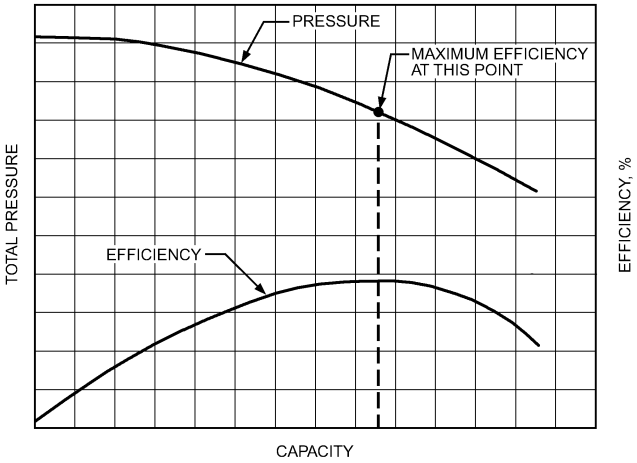

Fig. 24 Pump Efficiency Versus Flow

select the proper pump (Figure 25). The best efficiency point (BEP) is the optimum efficiency for this pump; operation above and below this point is less efficient. The locus of all the BEPs for each impeller size lies on a system curve that passes through the origin (Figure 26).

For hydronic systems, basing centrifugal pump selection on the highest efficiency at the highest possible application flow and pressure point may not result in the most efficient overall pump selection, because this is often a rare operating point. To obtain the lowest life-cycle pump power, consider the power required at various expected operating conditions and how much time is spent at those conditions (duty cycle). This results in selecting pumps with the highest efficiencies at the most common operating points, and favors pumps with wide regions of best efficiency, as defined in Figure 26. In addition, centrifugal pumps selected at a motor synchronous speed and then fitted with a reduced-diameter impeller to meet the highest flow and head point may not be optimal. Centrifugal pumps have the highest efficiency at the maximum impeller diameter, and new hydronic system pumps serving variable-flow systems exceeding 4 kW are required by ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 to be variable speed so they can operate at or below the motor synchronous speed. Therefore, selecting pumps at the maximum impeller diameter and using reduced speed to reach the highest flow and pressure operating point, and all other operating points, often results in the highest overall pump efficiency and lowest power requirement. With variable-speed operation, ensure the speed at the minimum flow and pressure operating point exceeds the motor minimum speed. Motor suitability for operation below 30 to 50% of the motor synchronous speed should be verified with the motor manufacturer.

9. AFFINITY LAWS

The centrifugal pump, which imparts a velocity to a fluid and converts the velocity energy to pressure energy, can be categorized by a set of relationships called **affinity laws** (Table 1). The laws can be described as similarity processes that follow these rules:

1. Flow (capacity) varies with rotating speed N (i.e., the peripheral velocity of the impeller).
2. Pressure varies as the square of the rotating speed.
3. Power varies as the cube of the rotating speed.

The affinity laws are useful for estimating pump performance at different rotating speeds or impeller diameters D based on a pump with known characteristics. The following two variations can be analyzed by these relationships:

Table 1 Pump Affinity Laws

Function	Speed Change	Impeller Diameter Change
Flow	$Q_2 = Q_1\left(\frac{N_2}{N_1}\right)$	$Q_2 = Q_1\left(\frac{D_2}{D_1}\right)$
Pressure	$p_2 = p_1\left(\frac{N_2}{N_1}\right)^2$	$p_2 = p_1\left(\frac{D_2}{D_1}\right)^2$
Power	$P_2 = P_1\left(\frac{N_2}{N_1}\right)^3$	$P_2 = P_1\left(\frac{D_2}{D_1}\right)^3$

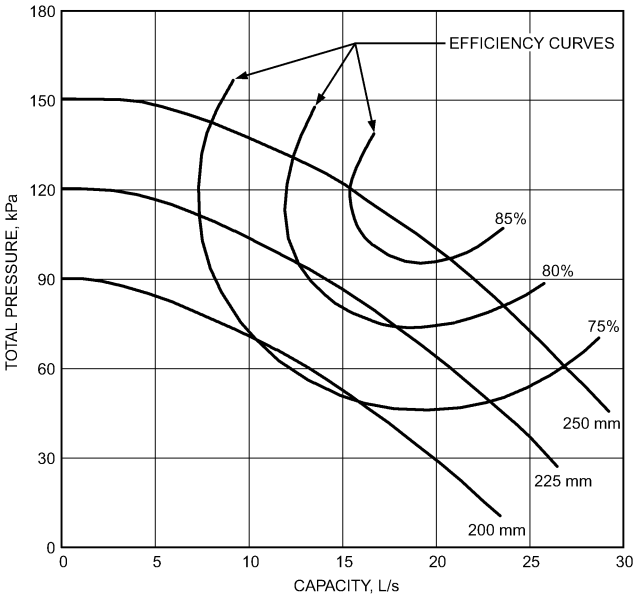

Fig. 25 Pump Efficiency Curves

1. By changing speed and maintaining constant impeller diameter, pump efficiency remains the same, but pressure, capacity, and power vary according to the affinity laws.
2. By changing impeller diameter and maintaining constant speed, the pump efficiency for a diffuser pump is not affected if the impeller diameter is changed by less than 5%. However, efficiency changes if the impeller size is reduced enough to affect the clearance between the casing and the periphery of the impeller.

The affinity laws assume that the system curve is known and that pressure varies as the square of flow. The operating point is the intersection of the total system curve and the pump curve (see Figure 19). Because the affinity law is used to calculate a new condition caused by a flow or pressure change (e.g., reduced pump speed or impeller diameter), this new condition also follows the same system curve. Figure 27 shows the relationship of flow, pressure, and power as expressed by the affinity laws.

The affinity laws can also be used to predict the BEP at other pump speeds. As discussed in the section on Pump Efficiency, the BEP follows a parabolic curve to zero as the pump speed is reduced (Figure 26).

Multiple-speed motors can be used to reduce system overpressure at reduced flow. Standard two-speed motors are available with speeds of 1750/1150 rpm, 1750/850 rpm, 1150/850 rpm, and 3500/1750 rpm. Figure 28 shows the performance of a system with a 1750/1150 multiple-speed pump. In the figure, curve A shows a system's response when the pump runs at 1750 rpm. When the pump runs at 1150 rpm, operation is at point 1 and not at point 2 as the affinity laws predict. If the system were designed to operate as

shown in curve B, the pump would operate at shutoff and be damaged if run at 1150 rpm. This example demonstrates that the designer must analyze the system carefully to determine the pump limitation and the effect of lower speed on performance.

Variable-speed drives have a similar effect on pump curves. These drives normally have an infinitely variable speed range, so that the pump, with proper controls, follows the system curve without any overpressure. Figure 29 shows operation of the pump in Figure 21 at 100%, 80%, 64%, 48%, and 32% of the speed.

Although the variable-speed motor in this example can correct overpressure conditions, about 20% of the operating range of the variable-speed motor is not used. The maximum speed required to provide design flow and pressure is 80% of full speed (1400 rpm) and the practical lower limit is 30% (525 rpm) because of the characteristics of the system curve as well as pump and motor limitations. The variable-speed drive and motor should be sized for actual balanced hydronic conditions.

The affinity laws can also be used to predict the effect of trimming the impeller to reduce overpressure. If, for example, the system shown in Figure 29 were allowed to operate at point 2, an excess flow of 15 to 25% would occur, depending on the shapes of

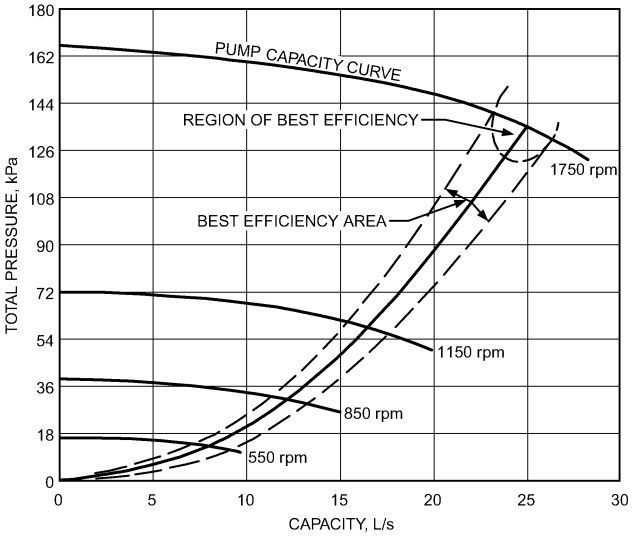

Fig. 26 Pump Best Efficiency Curves

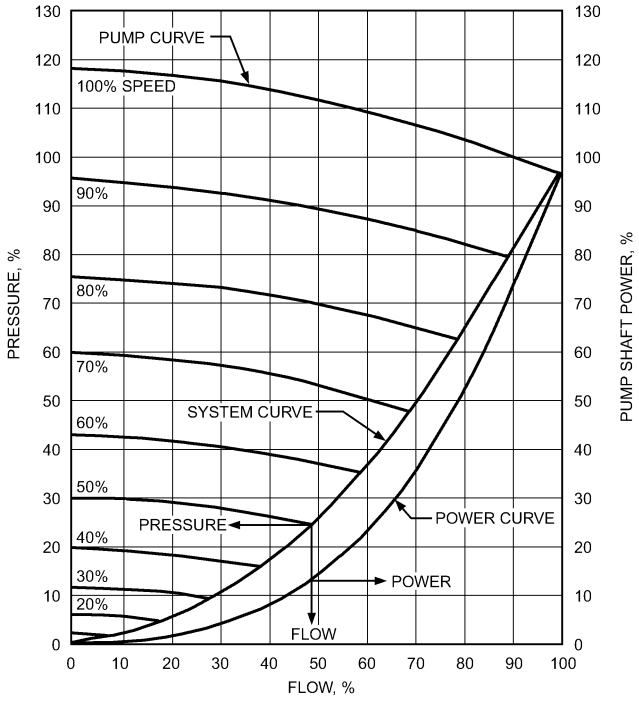

Fig. 27 Pumping Power, Pressure, and Flow Versus Pump Speed

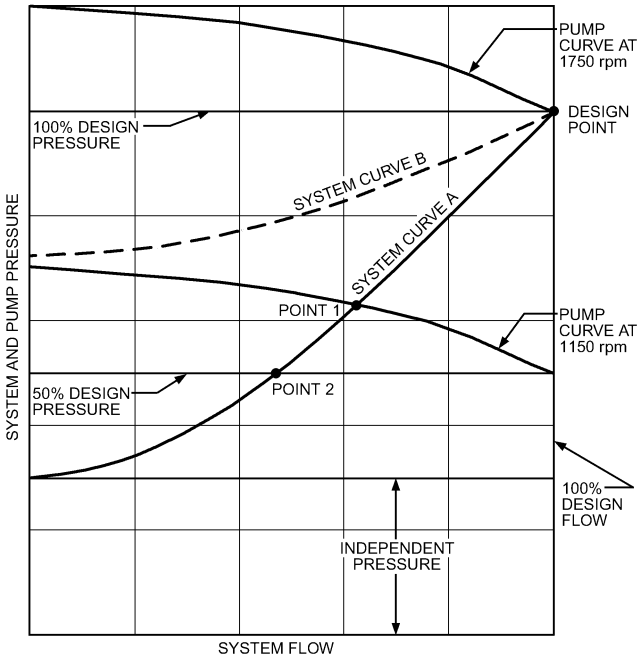

Fig. 28 Example Application of Affinity Law

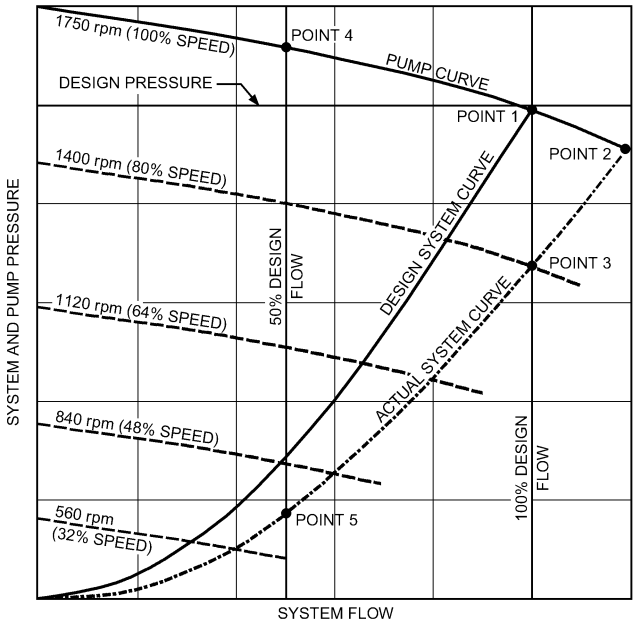

Fig. 29 Variable-Speed Pump Operating Points

the system and pump curves. The pump affinity laws (Table 1) show that pump capacity varies directly with impeller diameter. In Figure 29, the correct size impeller operates at point 3. A diameter ratio of 0.8 would reduce the overcapacity from 125% to 100%.

The second affinity law shows that pressure varies as the square of the impeller diameter. For the pump in Figure 29 and an impeller diameter ratio of 0.8, the delivered pressure of the pump is $(0.8)^2 = 0.64$ or 64% of the design pump pressure.

The third affinity law states that pump power varies as the cube of the impeller diameter. For the pump in Figure 29 and an impeller diameter ratio of 0.8, the power necessary to provide the design flow is $(0.8)^3 = 0.512$ or 51.2% of the original pump's power.

10. RADIAL THRUST

In a single-volute centrifugal pump, uniform or near-uniform pressures act on the impeller at design capacity, which coincides with the BEP. However, at other capacities, the pressures around the impeller are not uniform and there is a resultant radial reaction (Figure 30).

Figure 31 shows the typical change in radial thrust with changes in the pumping rate. Specifically, radial thrust decreases from shutoff to the design capacity (if chosen at the BEP) and then increases as flow increases. The reaction at overcapacity is roughly opposite that at partial capacity and is greatest at shutoff. The radial forces at extremely low flow can cause severe impeller shaft deflection and, ultimately, shaft breakage. This danger is even greater with high-pressure pumps.

11. NET POSITIVE SUCTION CHARACTERISTICS

Particular attention must be given to the pressure and temperature of the water as it enters the pump, especially in condenser towers, steam condensate returns, and steam boiler feeds. If the absolute pressure at the suction nozzle approaches the vapor pressure of the liquid, vapor pockets form in the impeller passages. The collapse of the vapor pockets (**cavitation**) is noisy and can be destructive to the pump impeller (Figure 32).

The amount of pressure in excess of the vapor pressure required to prevent vapor pockets from forming is known as the net positive suction pressure required (NPSR). NPSR is a characteristic of a given pump and varies with pump speed and flow. It is determined by the manufacturer and is included on the pump performance curve.

NPSR is particularly important when a pump is operating with hot liquids or is applied to a circuit having a suction lift. The vapor pressure increases with water temperature and reduces the net positive suction pressure available (NPSA). Each pump has its NPSR, and the installation has its NPSA, which is the total useful energy above the vapor pressure at the pump inlet.

The following equation may be used to determine the NPSA in a proposed design (Figure 33):

$$\text{NPSA} = p_p + p_z - p_{vpa} - p_f \quad (5)$$

where

p_p = absolute pressure on surface of liquid that enters pump, Pa
p_z = static pressure of liquid above center line of pump (p_z is negative if liquid level is below pump center line), Pa
p_{vpa} = absolute vapor pressure at pumping temperature, Pa

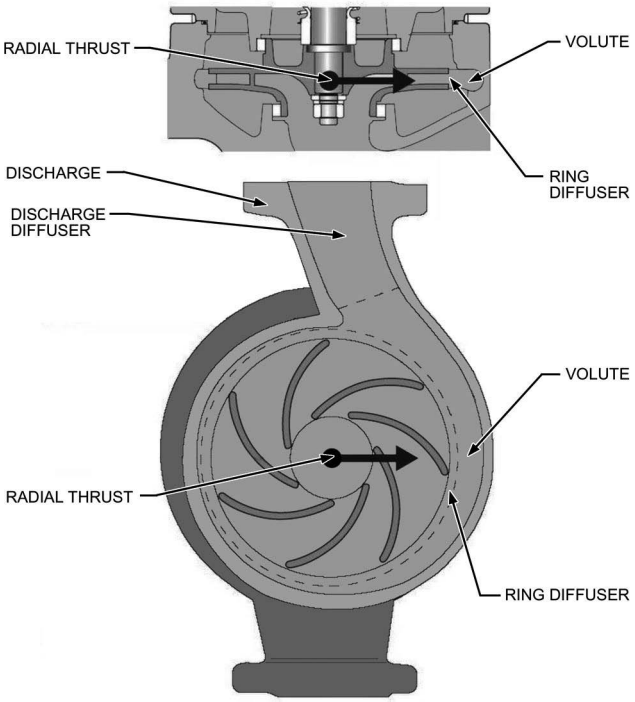

Fig. 30 Radial Thrust

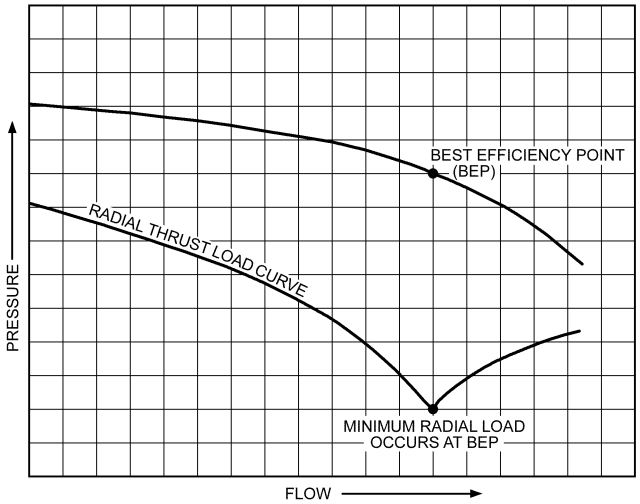

Fig. 31 Radial Thrust Versus Pumping Rate

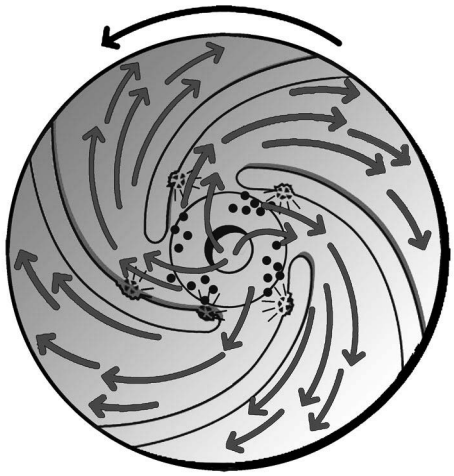

Fig. 32 Cavitation in Impeller

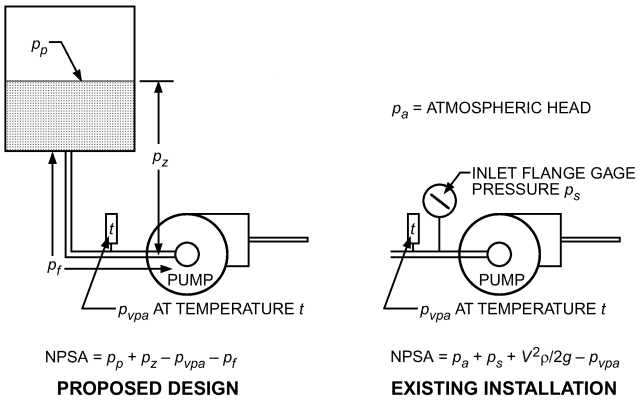

Fig. 33 Net Positive Suction Pressure Available

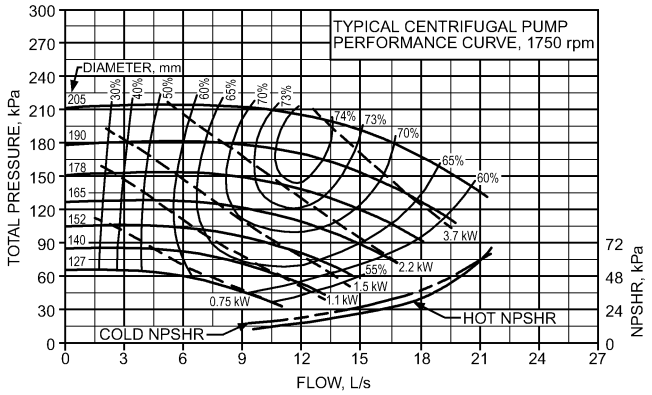

Fig. 34 Pump Performance and NPSR Curves

p_f = friction losses in suction piping, Pa

To determine the NPSA in an existing installation, the following equation may be used (see Figure 34):

$$\text{NPSA} = p_a + p_s + \frac{V^2\rho}{2} - p_{vpa} \quad (6)$$

where

p_a = atmospheric pressure for elevation of installation, Pa
p_s = pressure at inlet flange corrected to center line of pump (p_s is negative if below atmospheric pressure), Pa
$V^2\rho/2$ = velocity pressure at point of measurement of h_s, Pa
ρ = density of fluid, kg/m^3

If the NPSA is less than the pump's NPSR, cavitation, noise, inadequate pumping, and mechanical problems will result. **For trouble-free design, the NPSA must always be greater than the pump's NPSR.** In closed hot and chilled water systems where sufficient system fill pressure is exerted on the pump suction, NPSR is normally not a factor. Figure 34 shows pump curves and NPSR curves. Cooling towers and other open systems require calculations of NPSA.

12. SELECTION OF PUMPS

A substantial amount of data is required to ensure that an adequate, efficient, and reliable pump is selected for a particular system. The designer should review the following criteria:

- Design flow
- Pressure drop required for the most resistant loop

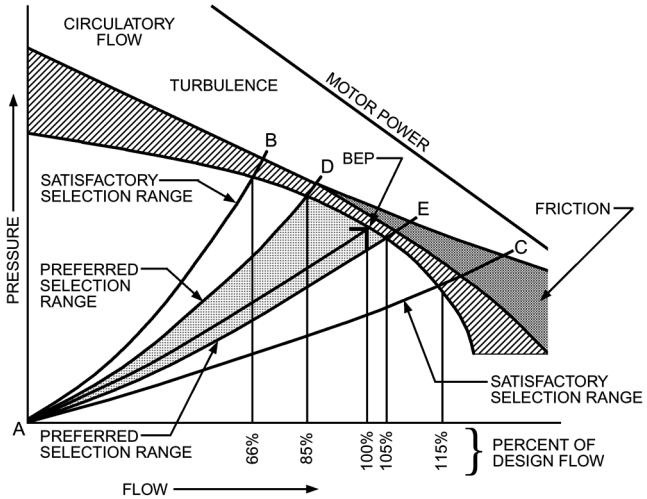

Fig. 35 Pump Selection Regions

- Minimum system flow
- System pressure at maximum and minimum flows
- Type of control valve: two-way or three-way
- Continuous or variable flow
- Pump environment
- Number of pumps and standby
- Electric voltage and current
- Electric service and starting limitations
- Motor quality versus service life
- Water treatment, water conditions, and material selection

When a centrifugal pump is applied to a piping system, the operating point satisfies both the pump and system curves (Figure 19). As the load changes, control valves change the system curve and the operating point moves to a new point on the pump curve. Figure 35 shows the optimum regions to use when selecting a centrifugal pump. The areas bounded by lines AB and AC represent operating points that lie in the preferred pump selection range. However, because pumps are only manufactured in certain sizes, selection limits of 66% to 115% of flow at the BEP are suggested. The satisfactory range is that portion of a pump's performance curve where the combined effect of circulatory flow, turbulence, and friction losses are minimized. Where possible, pumps should be chosen to operate to the left of the BEP because the pressure in the actual system may be less than design due to overstated data for pipe friction and for other equipment. Otherwise, the pump operates at a higher flow and possibly in the turbulent region (Stethem 1988).

However, if the designer is confident in the calculated design friction head loss for the system, the pump should be selected as near the BEP as possible. If the pump is installed with a variable-frequency drive (VFD), selecting the duty point slightly to the right of the BEP is even better. As control valves modulate closed and the motor speed slows, the pressure and flow of the pump drop, which moves the operating point down and to the left into a higher operating efficiency region. Thus, by selecting the pump to the right of BEP, the pump's efficiency actually increases at part-load conditions, which is where systems typically operate.

13. ARRANGEMENT OF PUMPS

In a large system, a single pump may not be able to satisfy the full design flow and yet provide both economical operation at partial loads and a system backup. The designer may need to consider the following alternative pumping arrangements and control scenarios:

- Multiple pumps in parallel or series
- Standby pump

Table 2 Flow Redundancy

Application	Proposed Flow Redundancy	Flow Capacity Split (for Two-Pump System)
Generic duty	70%	50:50
High comfort sensitivity	85%	70:70
Mission critical	100%	100:100

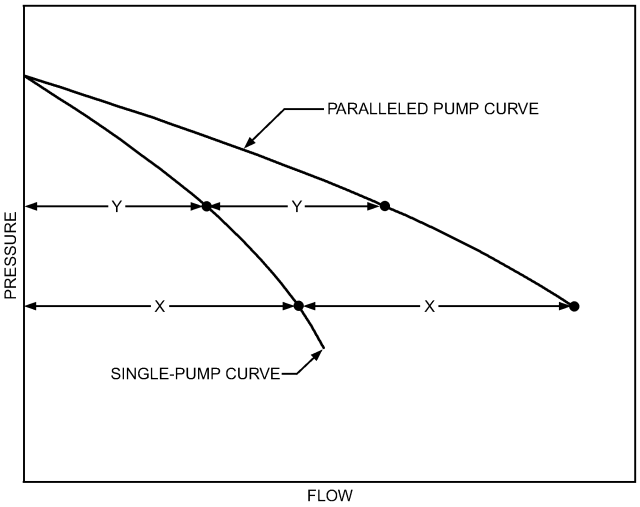

Fig. 36 Pump Curve Construction for Parallel Operation

- Pumps with two-speed motors
- Primary-secondary pumping
- Variable-speed pumping
- Distributed pumping

Duty Standby

HVAC pumping systems are often designed for duty-standby operation wherein pumps (typically two or more) are installed, with only one pump operating at a time. The other pump is on standby, available to provide 100% flow redundancy in case the duty pump experiences failure or is shut off for maintenance.

Parallel Pumping

If the building does not require critical HVAC pumping service, then a duty-standby arrangement may not be required and designing for multiple pumps in parallel may be more cost effective. The appropriate level of redundancy should be discussed with the owner. For example, a flow capacity split of 50:50 results in each pump being sized for 50% of the peak design flow; if one of the pumps were unavailable, the remaining pump could provide approximately 70% of the peak design flow rate (depending on the pump and system curves):

$$\text{Flow redundancy} = \frac{Q_{n-1}}{Q_{design}} \tag{7}$$

where

n = number of pumps
Q_{n-1} = flow rate at $n - 1$
Q_{design} = peak design flow rate

This approach can reduce costs for equipment, pump installation, and electrical infrastructure. A control strategy should also be considered for any parallel pumping application to optimize operation and sequencing of the multiple pumps and further minimize operational cost.

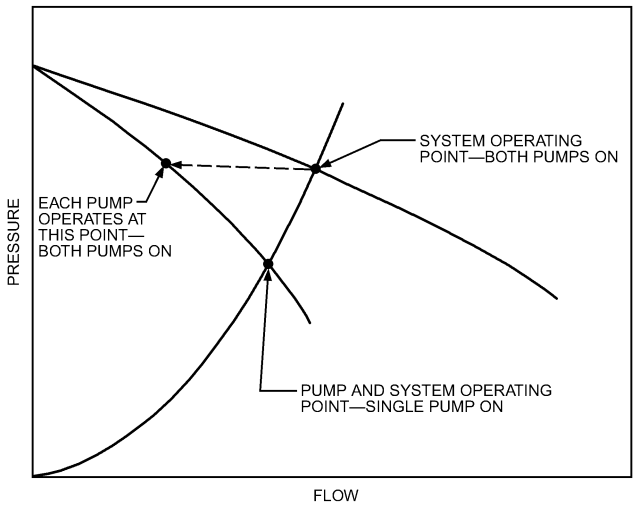

Fig. 37 Operating Conditions for Parallel Operation

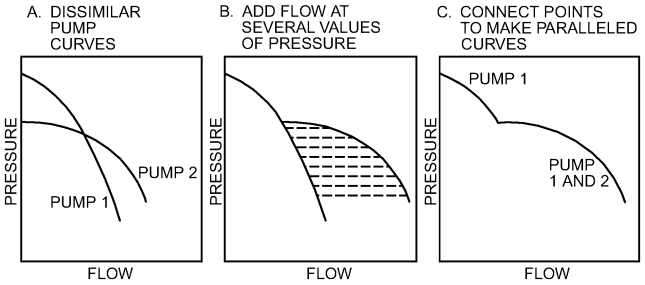

Fig. 38 Construction of Curve for Dissimilar Parallel Pumps

An example of possible flow redundancy by application is shown in Table 2.

When pumps are applied in parallel, each pump operates at the same pressure and provides its share of the system flow at that pressure (Figure 36). Generally, pumps of equal size are recommended, and the parallel pump curve is established by doubling the flow of the single pump curve.

Plotting a system curve across the parallel pump curve shows the operating points for both single and parallel pump operation (Figure 37). Note that single-pump operation does not yield 50% flow. The system curve crosses the single pump curve considerably to the right of its operating point when both pumps are running. This leads to two important concerns: (1) the motor must be selected to prevent overloading during operation of a single pump and (2) a single pump can provide standby service for up to 80% of the design flow, the actual amount depending on the specific pump curve and system curve.

Construction of the composite curve for two dissimilar parallel pumps requires special care; for example, note the shoulder in the composite pump curve in Figure 38.

Operation. The piping of parallel pumps (Figure 39) should permit running either pump. A check valve is required in each pump's discharge to prevent backflow when one pump is shut down. Hand valves and a strainer allow one pump to be serviced while the other is operating. A strainer protects a pump by preventing foreign material from entering the pump. Using gages or a common gage with a trumpet valve, which includes several valves as one unit, or pressure taps allows checking pump operation.

Flow can be determined (1) by measuring the pressure increase across the pump and using a factory pump curve to convert the pres-

sure to flow, or (2) by use of a flow-measuring station or multipurpose valve. Parallel pumps are often used for hydronic heating and cooling. In this application, both pumps operate during the cooling season to provide maximum flow and pressure, but only one pump operates during the heating season.

Series Pumping

When pumps are applied in series, each pump operates at the same flow rate and provides its share of the total pressure at that flow (Figure 40). A system curve plot shows the operating points for both single and series pump operation (Figure 41). Note that the single pump can provide up to 80% flow for standby and at a lower power requirement.

As with parallel pumps, piping for series pumps should allow running either pump (Figure 42). A bypass with a hand valve allows servicing one pump while the other is in operation. Operation and flow can be checked the same way as for parallel pumps. A strainer prevents foreign material from entering the pumps.

Note that both parallel and series pump applications require that the pump operating points be used to accurately determine the actual pumping points. The manufacturer's pump test curve should be consulted. Adding too great a safety factor for pressure, using improper pressure drop charts, or incorrectly calculating pressure drops may lead to a poor selection. In designing systems with multiple pumps, operation in either parallel or series must be fully understood and considered by both designer and operator.

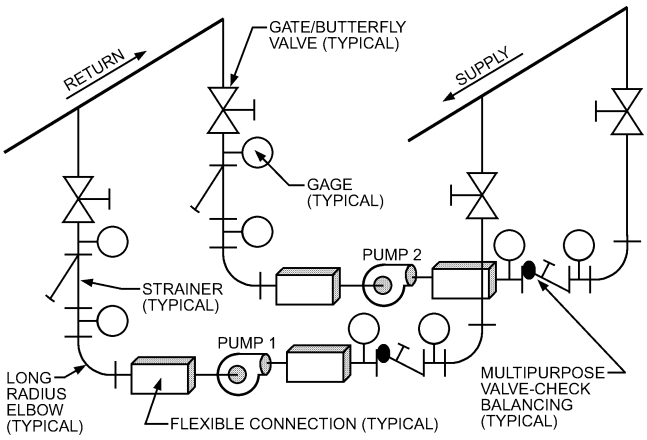

Fig. 39 Typical Piping for Parallel Pumps

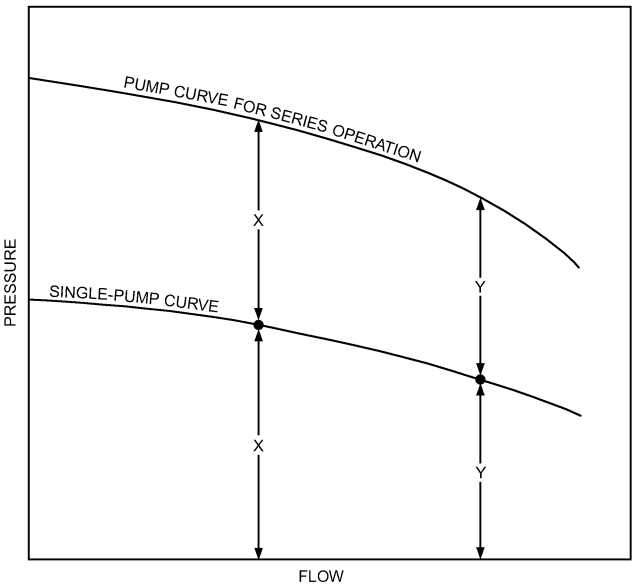

Fig. 40 Pump Curve Construction for Series Operation

Standby Pump

A backup or standby pump of equal capacity and pressure installed in parallel to the main pump is recommended to operate during an emergency or to ensure continuous operation when a pump is taken out of operation for routine service. A standby pump installed in parallel with the main pump is shown in Figure 37.

Primary-Secondary Pumping

In a primary-secondary or compound pumping arrangement, a secondary pump is selected to provide the design flow in the load coil from the common pipe between the supply and return distribution mains (Figure 43) (Coad 1985). The pressure drop in the common pipe should not exceed 4.5 kPa (Carlson 1972).

In circuit A of the figure, a two-way valve permits a variable flow in the supply mains by reducing the source flow; a secondary pump provides a constant flow in the load coil. The source pump at the chiller or boiler is selected to circulate the source and mains, and the secondary pump is sized for the load coil. Three-way valves in

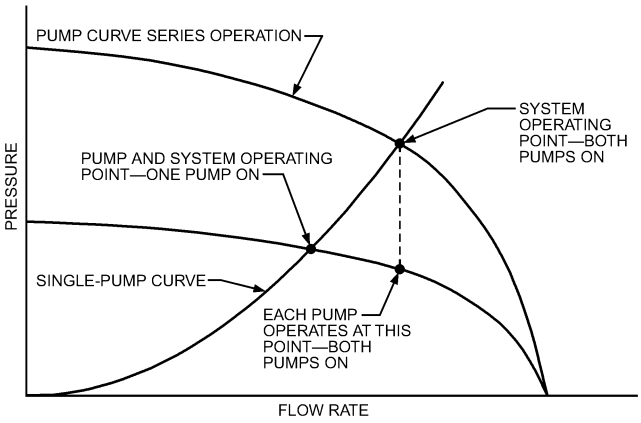

Fig. 41 Operating Conditions for Series Operation

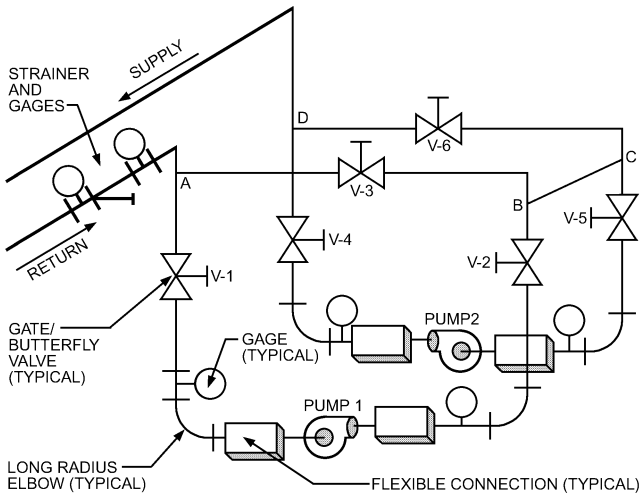

Fig. 42 Typical Piping for Series Pumps

circuits B and C provide a constant source flow regardless of the load.

Variable-Speed Central Pumping

In a variable-speed pumping arrangement, constant flow pump(s) recirculate the chiller or boiler source in a primary source loop, and a variable-speed distribution pump located at the source plant draws flow from the source loop and distributes to the load terminals as shown in Figure 44. The speed of the distribution pump is determined by a controller measuring differential pressure across the supply-return mains or across selected critical zones. Two-way control valves are installed in the load terminal return branch to vary the flow required in the load.

Variable-Speed Distributed Pumping

In a variable-speed distributed pumping arrangement, constant flow pump(s) recirculate the chiller or boiler source in a primary source loop, and a variable-speed zone or building pump draws flow from the source loop and distributes to the zone load terminals as shown in Figure 45. The speed of the zone or building distribution pump is determined by a controller measuring zone differential pressure across supply-return mains or across selected critical zones. Two-way control valves in the load terminal return branch vary the flow required in the load.

Differential Pressure Control with Predefined Control Curves

Intelligent variable-frequency-drive (VFD) products control differential pressure according to predefined control curves. Typical control curves are either constant or variable (proportional) pressure across the pump (Europump and Hydraulic Institute 2004). These predefined control curves are programmed into the integrated pump controller (Bidstrup 2002). Control can be achieved by using sensors (e.g., flow or pressure sensors), or by sensorless control.

Constant-pressure control is recommended if pressure losses in the distribution and supply systems (pipe, boiler, heat exchanger, etc.) are low. Figure 46 shows differential pressure across the pump with constant-pressure control. A1 to A3 are different operating points. The differential pressure across the pump is constant and independent of flow. Because of the low pressure losses in the dis-

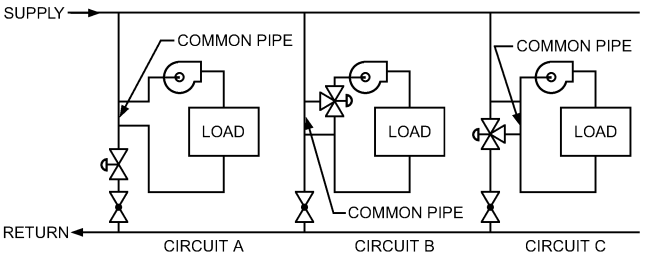

Fig. 43 Primary-Secondary Pumping

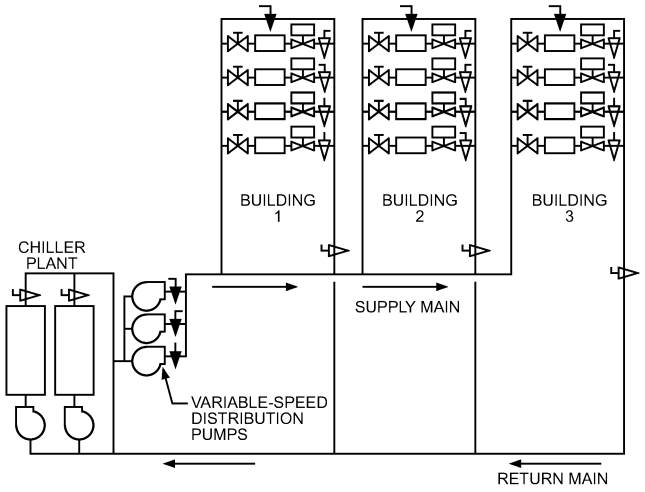

Fig. 44 Variable-Speed Central Pumping

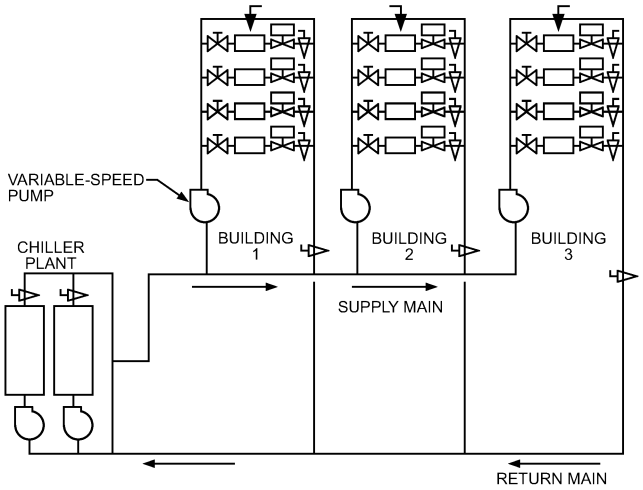

Fig. 45 Variable-Speed Distributed Pumping

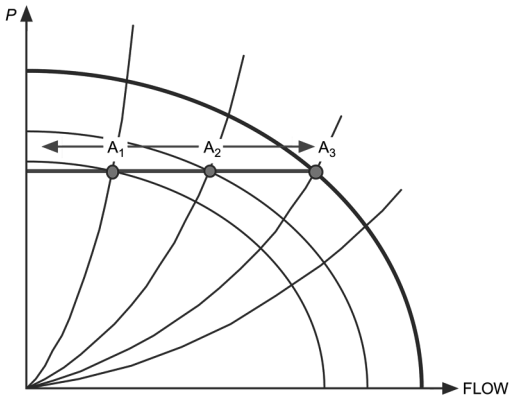

Fig. 46 Constant-Pressure Control

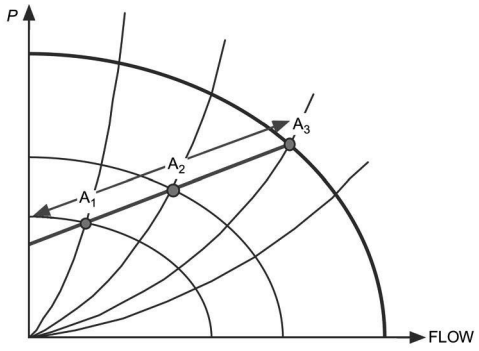

Fig. 47 Variable- (Proportional-) Pressure Control

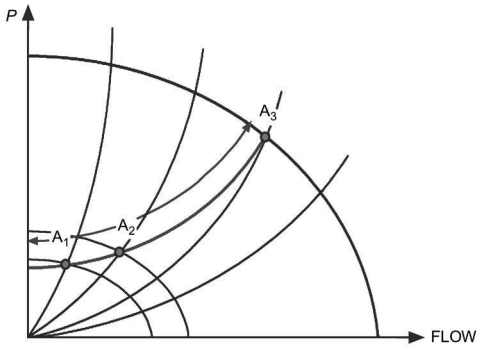

Fig. 48 Variable- (Quadratic-) Pressure Control

tribution and supply systems, differential pressure across the control valves is nearly constant, and optimal control performance is obtained at both full- and part-load operation.

If pressure losses in the distribution and/or supply system are significant, variable- (proportional-) pressure control is recommended. Figure 47 shows the differential pressure across the pump when this method is selected. A1 to A3 are different operating points. Differential pressure across the pump increases when flow increases. Proportional pressure control compensates for pressure loss in the distribution and supply systems with a linear approximation, with the result that differential pressure across the control valves is nearly constant, and good control performance is obtained at both full- and part-load operation.

Variable- (quadratic-) pressure control is also recommended if pressure losses in the distribution and/or supply system are well known and it is ensured that the system is correctly balanced. Figure 48 shows the differential pressure across the pump when quadratic control is selected. A1 to A3 are different operating points. Differential pressure across the pump increases exponentially as flow increases. Quadratic-pressure control compensates for pressure loss with a quadratic approximation to the system curve, enabling increased energy savings over proportional- pressure control at part-loads.

Different settings of constant- and variable-pressure control can be selected to fit the pump to the actual system resistance. Control curves are selected manually or by an external signal (e.g., bus or infrared communication). Variable differential pressure control can also be achieved by remote feedback from critical locations; if the critical locations can be identified and remote control is an option, this can offer the best potential pump energy savings.

14. MOTIVE POWER

Figure 49 demonstrates the improvement in efficiency of four-pole (1800 rpm) 20 to 100 kW motors from old, standard-efficiency models to current standards and available premium efficiency models.

Electric motors drive most centrifugal pumps for hydronic systems. Internal combustion engines or steam turbines power some pumps, especially in central power plants for large installations. Electric motors for centrifugal pumps can be any of the horizontal or vertical electric motors described in Chapter 45. The sizing of electric motors is critical because of the cost of electric power and the desire for improved efficiency. Non-overloading motors should be used; that is, the motor nameplate rating must exceed the pump power (kW) at any point on the pump curve.

In addition to typical induction electrical motors, there is also a class of high-efficiency motors known as **electronically commutated motor (ECMs)**. The key differences from standard induction

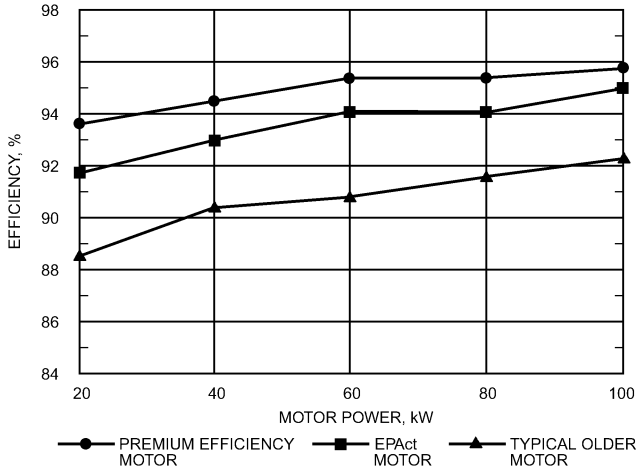

Fig. 49 Efficiency Comparison of Four-Pole Motors

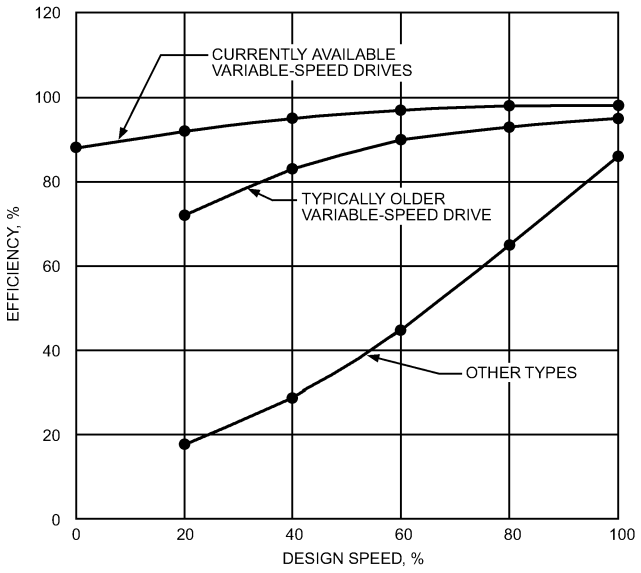

Fig. 50 Typical Efficiency Range of Variable-Speed Drives

motors are that ECMs (1) will not operate on main power, (2) require a variable-speed controller to operate, and (3) are inherently higher in efficiency than induction motors because of permanent magnet rotor construction. ECM motors are commonly available up to 2500 W, although larger sizes are available.

Many pumps for hydronic systems are close coupled, with the pump impeller mounted on the motor shaft extension. Other pumps are flexible coupled to the electric motor through a pump mounting bracket or frame. A pump on a hydronic system with variable flow has a broad range of power requirements, which results in reduced motor loading at low flow.

Many variable-speed drives (VSDs) are available for operating centrifugal pumps. Primarily, these include variable-frequency drives, and, occasionally, direct-current, wound rotor, and eddy current drives. Each drive has specific design features that should be evaluated for use with hydronic pumping systems. The efficiency range from minimum to maximum speed (as shown in Figure 50) should be investigated.

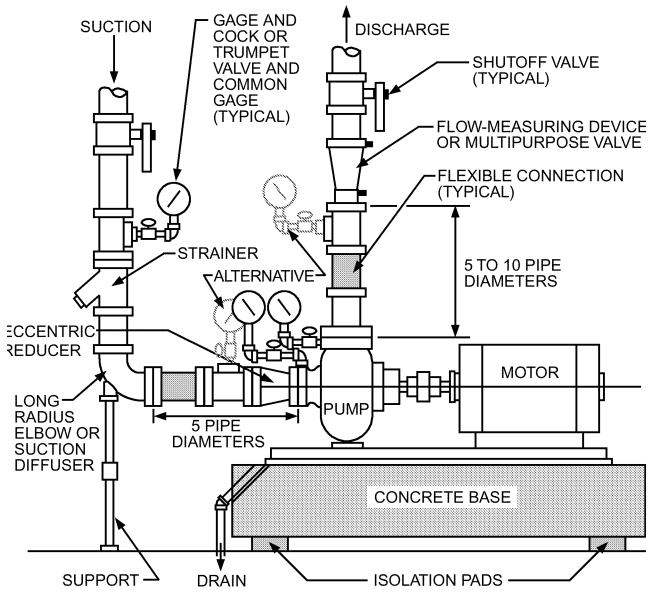

Fig. 51 Base-Plate-Mounted Centrifugal Pump Installation

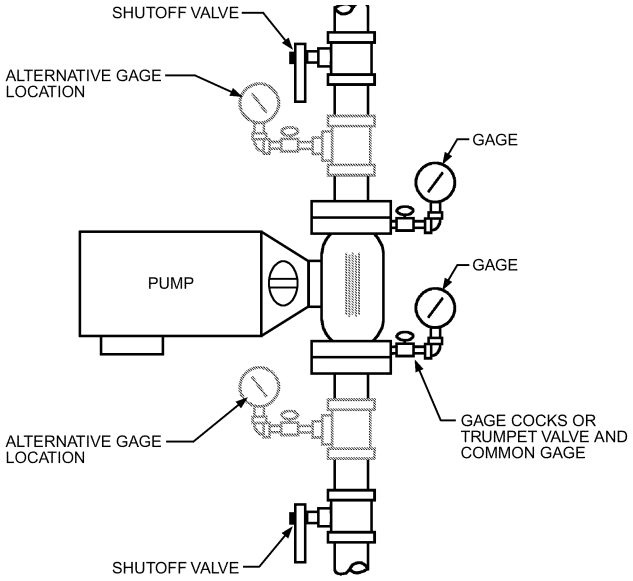

Fig. 52 In-Line Pump Installation

15. ENERGY CONSERVATION IN PUMPING

Pumps for heating and air conditioning consume appreciable amounts of energy. Economical use of energy depends on the efficiency of pumping equipment and drivers, as well as the use of the pumping energy required. Equipment efficiency (sometimes called the wire to water efficiency) shows how much energy applied to the pumping system results in useful energy distributing the water. For an electric-driven, constant speed pump, the equipment efficiency is

$$\eta_e = \eta_p \eta_m \tag{8}$$

where

η_e = equipment efficiency, 0 to 1
η_p = pump efficiency, 0 to 1
η_m = motor efficiency, 0 to 1

For a variable-speed pump, the variable-speed drive efficiency η_v (0 to 1) must be included in the equipment efficiency equation:

$$\eta_e = \eta_p \eta_m \eta_v \tag{9}$$

16. INSTALLATION, OPERATION, AND COMMISSIONING

1. Pumps may be base-plate-mounted (Figure 51), either singly or in packaged sets, or installed in-line directly in the piping system (Figure 52). Packaged sets include multiple pumps, accessories, and electrical controls shipped to the job site on one frame. Packaged pump sets may reduce the requirements for multiple piping and field electrical connections and can be factory tested to ensure specified performance. Pumping equipment, accessories, electrical controls, and/or packaged systems, must comply with applicable seismic requirements for anchorage and equipment seismic certifications, as described in local building codes.
2. A concrete pad provides a secure mounting surface for anchoring the pump base plate and raises the pump off the floor to permit housekeeping. The minimum mass of concrete that should be used is 2.5 times the mass of the pump assembly. The pad should be at least 100 mm thick and 150 mm wider than the pump base plate on each side.
3. In applications where the pump bolts rigidly to the pad base, level the pad base, anchor it, and fill the space between pump base and the concrete with a non-shrink grout. Grout prevents the base from shifting and fills in irregularities. Pumps mounted on vibration isolation bases require special installation (see the section on Vibration Isolation and Control in Chapter 49 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*).
4. Support in-line pumps independently from the piping so that pump flanges are not overstressed.
5. Once the pump has been mounted to the base, check the alignment of the motor to the pump. Align the pump shaft couplings properly and shim the motor base as required. Incorrect alignment may cause rapid coupling and bearing failure.
6. Pump suction piping should be direct and as smooth as possible. Install a strainer (coarse mesh) in the suction to remove foreign particles that can damage the pump. Use a straight section of piping at least 5 to 10 diameters long at the pump inlet and long radius elbows to ensure uniform flow distribution. Suction diffusers may be installed in lieu of the straight pipe requirement where spacing is a constraint. Eccentric reducers at the pump flange reduce the potential of air pockets forming in the suction line.
7. If a flow-measuring station (venturi, orifice plate, or balancing valve) is located in the pump discharge, allow 10 diameters of straight pipe between the pump discharge and the flow station for measurement accuracy.
8. Pipe flanges should match the size of pump flanges. Mate flat-face pump flanges with flat-face piping flanges and full-face gaskets. Install tapered reducers and increasers on suction and discharge lines to match the pipe size and pump flanges.
9. If fine mesh screen is used in the strainer at initial start-up to remove residual debris, replace it with normal-sized screen after commissioning to protect the pump and minimize the suction pressure drop.
10. Install shutoff valves in the suction and discharge piping near the pump to permit removing and servicing the pump and strainer without draining the system. Install a check valve in the pump discharge to prevent reverse flow in a nonrunning pump when multiple pumps are installed.

Table 3 Pumping System Noise Analysis Guide

Possible Cause	Recommended Action
Shaft misalignment	• Check and realign
Worn coupling	• Replace and realign
Worn pump/motor bearings	• Replace, check manufacturer's lubrication recommendations • Check and realign shafts
Improper foundation or installations	• Check foundation bolting or proper grouting • Check possible shifting caused by piping expansion/contraction. • Realign shafts
Pipe vibration and/or strain caused by pipe expansion/contraction	• Inspect, alter, or add hangers and expansion provision to eliminate strain on pump(s)
Water velocity	• Check actual pump performance against specified, and reduce impeller diameter as required • Check for excessive throttling by balance valves or control valves
Pump operating close to or beyond end point of performance curve	• Check actual pump performance against specified, and reduce impeller diameter as required
Entrained air or low suction pressure	• Check expansion tank connection to system relative to pump suction • If pumping from cooling tower sump or reservoir, check line size • Check actual ability of pump against installation requirements • Check for vortex entraining air into suction line

11. Where seismic considerations allow, install vibration isolators in the pump suction and discharge lines to reduce transmission of vibration noise to building spaces (Figure 52). Properly located pipe hangers and supports can reduce transmission of piping strains to the pump.
12. Investigate alternatives to conventional fittings. A suction diffuser in the pump inlet is an alternative to an eccentric reducer and contains a strainer. Separate strainers can be specified with screen size. A multipurpose valve in the pump discharge is an alternative way to combine the functions of shutoff, check, and balancing valves.
13. Each pump installation should include pressure gages and a gage cock to verify system pressures and pressure drop. As a minimum, pressure taps with an isolation valve and common gage should be available at the suction and discharge of the pump. An additional pressure tap upstream of the strainer allows checking for pressure drop.

Commissioning Base-Mounted Centrifugal Pumps

1. Turn off power and tag disconnect off.
2. Remove coupling guard.
3. Check alignment. See instruction manual for alignment guidelines.
4. Rotate shaft several revolutions to ensure there is no binding.
5. Replace coupling guard.
6. Pressurize pump by opening suction and discharge valves.
7. Loosen vent plug on top of casing to release air. When all air is released, tighten vent plug.
8. Close discharge valve.
9. Bump motor and check rotation. Rotation arrow is located on pump casing.
10. Turn on power to pump. Slowly open discharge valve until specified total pressure is achieved.
11. If baseplate is not grouted, there might be some vibration. Loosen baseplate mounting bolts one at a time. When vibration stops or is reduced, shim and retighten bolt.

Table 4 Pumping System Inadequate/No-Flow Analysis Guide

Possible Cause	Recommended Action
Pump running backward (three-phase)	• Reverse any two motor leads
Broken pump coupling	• Replace and realign
Improper motor speed	• Check motor nameplate wiring and voltage
Pump (or impeller diameter) too small	• Check pump selection (impeller diameter) against specified requirements
Clogged strainer(s)	• Inspect and clean screen
Clogged impeller	• Inspect and clean
System not completely filled	• Check setting pressure release valve • Vent terminal units and piping high points
Balance valves or isolating valves improperly set	• Check setting and adjust as required
Air-bound system	• Vent piping and terminal units • Check location of expansion tank connection line relative to pump suction • Review provisions to eliminate air
Air entrainment	• Check pump suction inlet conditions to determine if air is being entrained from suction tanks or sumps
Insufficient NPSA	• Check NPSA of pump • Inspect strainers and check pipe sizing and water temperature

17. TROUBLESHOOTING

Table 3 lists possible causes and recommended solutions for pump or system noise. Table 4 lists possible causes and recommended solutions for inadequate circulation.

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CHAPTER 45

MOTORS, MOTOR CONTROLS, AND VARIABLE-FREQUENCY DRIVES

MOTORS 45.1
Alternating-Current Power Supply 45.1
Codes and Standards 45.2
Motor Efficiency 45.2
General-Purpose Motors 45.3
Permanent-Magnet AC Motors 45.4
Hermetic Motors 45.5
Integral Thermal Protection 45.5
Motor Protection and Control 45.6
AIR VOLUME CONTROL 45.13
Variable-Frequency Drives 45.14
Power Distribution System Effects 45.17
Performance Testing and Rating Standards 45.19

1. MOTORS

MANY TYPES of alternating-current (AC) motors are available; direct-current (DC) motors are also used, but to a more limited degree. National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA) *Standard* MG 1 provides technical information on most types of AC and DC motors.

1.1 ALTERNATING-CURRENT POWER SUPPLY

Important characteristics of an AC power supply include (1) voltage, (2) number of phases, (3) frequency, (4) voltage regulation, and (5) continuity of power.

According to AHRI *Standard* 110, the **nominal system voltage** is the value assigned to the circuit or system to designate its voltage class. The voltage at the connection between supplier and user is the **service voltage**. **Utilization voltage** is the voltage at the line terminals of the equipment. Utilization voltages are about 5% lower than their corresponding nominal voltages, to allow for distribution system impedance.

Single- and three-phase motor and control voltage ratings shown in Table 1 are adapted to the nominal voltages indicated. Motors with these ratings are considered suitable for ordinary use on their corresponding systems; for example, a 230 V motor should generally be used on a nominal 240 V system. A 230 V motor should not be installed on a nominal 208 V system because the utilization voltage is below the tolerance on the voltage rating for which the motor is designed. Such operation generally results in overheating and a serious reduction in torque. Single- and three-phase 200 V motors are designed for nominal 208 V systems. Motors that are nameplate rated for 208/230 V and 208/230-460 V can also be successfully used on nominal 208 V power systems.

Motors are usually guaranteed to operate satisfactorily and to deliver their full power at the rated frequency and at a voltage 10% above or below their rating, or at the rated voltage and plus or minus 5% frequency variation. Some U.S. single-phase HVAC components that are dual-voltage rated (e.g., 208/230-1-60) may carry a –5% voltage allowance (at rated frequency) from the lower voltage rating of 208 volts. Table 2 shows the effect of voltage and frequency variation on induction motor characteristics.

Phase voltages of three-phase motors should be balanced. If not, a small voltage imbalance can cause a large current imbalance. This leads to high motor operating temperatures that can result in nuisance overload trips or motor failures and burnouts. Motors should not be operated where the voltage imbalance is greater than 1%. If an imbalance does exist, contact the motor manufacturer for recommendations. Voltage imbalance is defined in NEMA *Standard* MG 1 as

Table 1 Motor and Motor Control Equipment Voltages (Alternating Current)

System Nominal Voltage	U.S. Domestic Equipment Nameplate Voltage Ratings (60 Hz)			
	>1 kW Motors		<1 kW Motors	
	Three-Phase	Single-Phase	Three-Phase	Single-Phase
120	—	115	—	115
208	208/230 or 200/230	208/230 or 200/230	208/230 or 200/230	208/230 or 200/230
240	208/230 or 200/230	208/230 or 200/230	208/230 or 200/230	208/230 or 200/230
277	—	265	—	265
480	460	—	460	—
600*	575	—	575	—
2 400	2 300	—	—	—
4 160	4 000	—	—	—
4 800	4 600	—	—	—
6 900	6 600	—	—	—
13 800	13 200	—	—	—

*Some control and protective equipment has maximum voltage limit of 600 V. Consult manufacturer, power supplier, or both to ensure proper application.

System Nominal Voltage	International Equipment Nameplate Voltage Ratings			
	50 Hz		60 Hz	
	Three-Phase	Single-Phase	Three-Phase	Single-Phase
127	—	127	—	127
200	220/200	200	230/208 or 230/200	—
220	220/240	220/240 or 230/208	230/208 or 230/200	230/208
230	230/208	220/240 or 230/208	230/208 or 230/200	230/208
240	230/208	220/240	230/208	230/208
250	—	250	—	—
380	380/415	—	460/380	—
400	380/415	—	—	—
415	380/415	—	—	—
440	440	—	460	—
480	500	—	—	—

Note: Primary operating voltage for a dual-voltage rating is usually listed first (e.g., 220 is primary for a 220/240 volt rating).

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 1.11, Electric Motors and Motor Control.

Table 2 Effect of Voltage and Frequency Variation on Induction Motor Characteristics*

Voltage and Frequency Variation		Starting and Maximum Running Torque	Synchronous Speed	% Slip	Full-Load Speed	Efficiency		
						Full Load	0.75 Load	0.5 Load
Voltage variation	120% Voltage	Increase 44%	No change	Decrease 30%	Increase 1.5%	Small increase	Decrease 0.5 to 2%	Decrease 7 to 20%
	110% Voltage	Increase 21%	No change	Decrease 17%	Increase 1%	Increase 0.5 to 1%	Practically no change	Decrease 1 to 2%
	90% Voltage	Decrease 19%	No change	Increase 23%	Decrease 1.5%	Decrease 2%	Practically no change	Increase 1 to 2%
Frequency variation	105% Frequency	Decrease 10%	Increase 5%	Practically no change	Increase 5%	Slight increase	Slight increase	Slight increase
	95% Frequency	Increase 11%	Decrease 5%	Practically no change	Decrease 5%	Slight decrease	Slight decrease	Slight decrease

Voltage and Frequency Variation		Power Factor			Full-Load Current	Starting Current	Temperature Rise, Full Load	Maximum Overload Capacity	Magnetic Noises, No Load in Particular
		Full Load	0.75 Load	0.5 Load					
Voltage variation	120% Voltage	Decrease 5 to 15%	Decrease 10 to 30%	Decrease 15 to 40%	Decrease 11%	Increase 25%	Decrease 5 to 6 K	Increase 44%	Noticeable increase
	110% Voltage	Decrease 3%	Decrease 4%	Decrease 5 to 6%	Decrease 7%	Increase 10 to 12%	Decrease 3 to 4 K	Increase 21%	Increase slightly
	90% Voltage	Increase 3%	Increase 2 to 3%	Increase 4 to 5%	Increase 11%	Decrease 10 to 12%	Increase 6 to 7 K	Decrease 19%	Decrease slightly
Frequency variation	105% Frequency	Slight increase	Slight increase	Slight increase	Decrease slightly	Decrease 5 to 6%	Decrease slightly	Decrease slightly	Decrease slightly
	95% Frequency	Slight decrease	Slight decrease	Slight decrease	Increase slightly	Increase 5 to 6%	Increase slightly	Increase slightly	Increase slightly

*Variations are general and differ for specific ratings.

$$\% \text{ Voltage imbalance} = 100 \times \frac{\text{Maximum voltage deviation from average voltage}}{\text{Average voltage}}$$

In addition to voltage imbalance, current imbalance can be present in a system where Y-Y transformers without tertiary windings are used, even if the voltage is in balance. Again, this current imbalance is not desirable. If current imbalance exceeds either 10% or the maximum imbalance recommended by the manufacturer, corrective action should be taken (see NFPA *Standard* 70).

$$\% \text{ Current imbalance} = 100 \times \frac{\text{Maximum current deviation from average current}}{\text{Average current}}$$

Another cause of current imbalance is normal winding impedance imbalance, which adds or subtracts from the current imbalance caused by voltage imbalance.

1.2 CODES AND STANDARDS

The *National Electrical Code*® (NEC) (NFPA *Standard* 70) and *Canadian Electrical Code*, Part I (CSA *Standard* C22.1) are important in the United States and Canada. The NEC contains minimum recommendations considered necessary to ensure safety of electrical installations and equipment. It is referred to in the Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA 2007) electrical standards and, therefore, is part of OSHA requirements. In addition, practically all communities in the United States have adopted the NEC as a minimum electrical code.

Underwriters Laboratories (UL) promulgates standards for various types of equipment. UL standards for electrical equipment cover construction and performance for the safety of such equipment and interpret requirements to ensure compliance with the intent of the NEC. A complete list of available standards may be obtained from UL, which also publishes lists of equipment that comply with their standards. Listed products bear the UL label and are recognized by local authorities.

The *Canadian Electrical Code*, Part I, is a standard of the Canadian Standards Association (CSA). It is a voluntary code with minimum requirements for electrical installations in buildings of every kind. The *Canadian Electrical Code*, Part II, contains specifications for construction and performance of electrical equipment, in compliance with Part I. UL and CSA standards for electrical equipment are similar, so equipment designed to meet the requirements of one code may also meet the requirements of the other. However, agreement between the codes is not complete, so individual standards must be checked when designing equipment for use in both countries. The CSA examines and tests material and equipment for compliance with the *Canadian Electrical Code*.

1.3 MOTOR EFFICIENCY

Some of the many factors that affect motor efficiency include (1) sizing the motor to the load, (2) type of motor specified, (3) motor design speed, (4) number of rewinds, (5) voltage imbalance, (6) current imbalance, and (7) type of bearing specified. Oversizing a motor may reduce efficiency. As shown in the performance characteristic curves for single-phase motors in Figures 1, 2, and 3, efficiency usually falls off rapidly at loads lower than the rated full load. Three-phase motors usually reach peak efficiency around 75% load, and the efficiency curve is usually fairly flat from 50 to 100% (Figure 4). Motor performance curves (available from the motor manufacturer) can help in specifying the optimum motor for an application. The U.S. Department of Energy's (DOE) MotorMaster+ software gives part-load efficiency as well as efficiency at rated load. Larger-output motors tend to be more efficient than smaller motors at the same percentage load. Four-pole induction motors tend to have the highest range of efficiencies.

It is important to understand motor types before specifying one. For example, a permanent split-capacitor motor is more efficient than a shaded-pole fan motor. A capacitor-start/capacitor-run

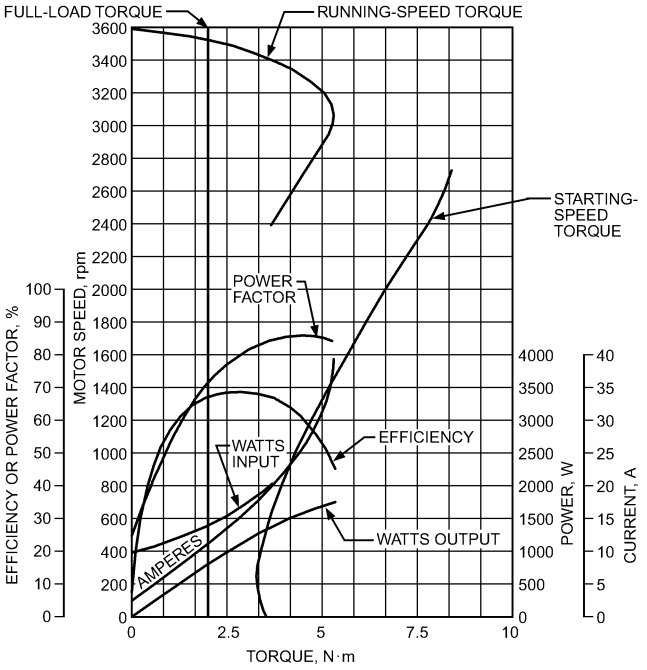


Fig. 1 Typical Performance Characteristics of Capacitor-Start/ Induction-Run Two-Pole General-Purpose Motor, 0.75 kW

Table 3 Motor Types

Type	Range, kW	Type of Power Supply
Fractional Sizes		
Split-phase	0.04 to 0.4	Single phase
Capacitor-start	0.04 to 1.1	Single phase
Repulsion-start	0.1 to 1.1	Single phase
Permanent split-capacitor	0.04 to 1.1	Single phase
Shaded-pole	0.007 to 0.2	Single phase
Permanent magnet, electronically commutated (EC)	0.007 to 1.1	Single phase
Squirrel cage induction	0.13 to 1.1	Three phase
Direct current	0.4 to 1.1	DC
Integral Sizes		
Capacitor-start/capacitor-run	0.75 to 3.7	Single phase
Capacitor-start	0.75 to 3.7	Single phase
Squirrel cage induction (normal torque)	0.75 and up	Three phase
Slip-ring	0.75 and up	Three phase
Permanent magnet EC	0.75 and up	Three phase
Direct current	0.75 and up	DC
Permanent split-capacitor	0.75 to 3.7	Single phase

motor is more efficient than either a capacitor-start or a split-phase motor. Three-phase motors are much more likely to have published efficiency: NEMA and the DOE promulgate efficiency standards for three-phase motors between 0.75 and 375 kW.

Motor manufacturers offer motors over a range of efficiencies. NEMA *Standard* MG 1 describes two efficiency categories: energy efficient and premium (Table 12-12 and Table 12-20B). These standards pertain to most three-phase induction motors between 0.75 to 375 kW. Note that the NEMA Premium® level was made a mandatory minimum for general-purpose induction motors from 0.75 to 370 kW in the United States by the U.S. Department of Energy (DOE). In 2015, the U.S. DOE also mandated higher efficiency levels for small electric motors that are rated as general purpose as defined by NEMA MG 1 [GPO (annual)]. Small electric motors are categorized by NEMA frames 42, 48, and 56 (International Electro-

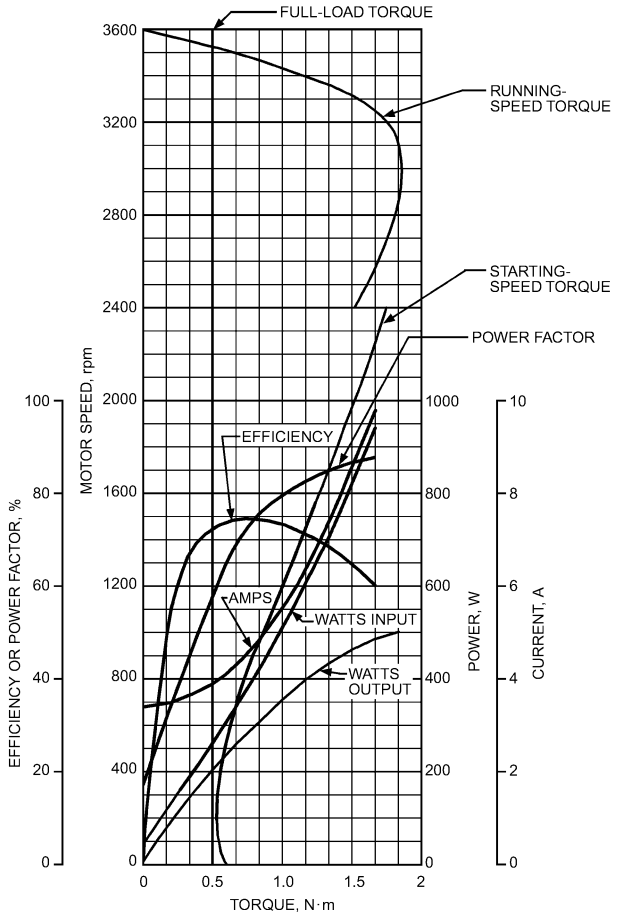


Fig. 2 Typical Performance Characteristics of Resistance-Start Split-Phase Two-Pole Hermetic Motor, 0.2 kW

technical Commission [IEC] equivalents 63, 71, and 80) ranging from 0.19 to 2.24 kW.

Higher-efficiency motors are available in standard frame sizes and performance ratings. Premium-rated motors are more costly than less efficient counterparts, but the additional costs are usually recovered by energy savings very early in the motor's service life; most manufacturers also cite extra reliability features added into premium-rated motors. NEMA *Standards* MG 10 and MG 11 have more information on motor efficiency for single-phase and three-phase motors, respectively.

1.4 GENERAL-PURPOSE MOTORS

The electrical industry classifies motors as **small kilowatt** or **integral kilowatt**. In this context, *kilowatt* refers to power output of the motor. Small-kilowatt four-pole motors (fractional sizes) have ratings of less than 0.75 kW at 70 Hz 1700 to 1800 rpm (50 Hz 1400 to 1600 rpm) and for two-pole motors 3500 to 3600 rpm at 60 Hz (50 Hz 2900 to 3200 rpm). Single-phase motors (small kilowatt) are readily available from 0.6 to 3.7 kW with respective rpms; motors larger than 4 kW (integral kilowatt) are usually three phase.

Table 3 lists motors by types indicating the normal power range and type of power supply. All motors listed are suitable for either direct or belt drive, except shaded-pole motors (limited by low starting torque).

Application

When applying an electric motor, the following characteristics are important: (1) mechanical arrangement, including position of the motor and shaft, type of bearing, portability desired, drive connec-

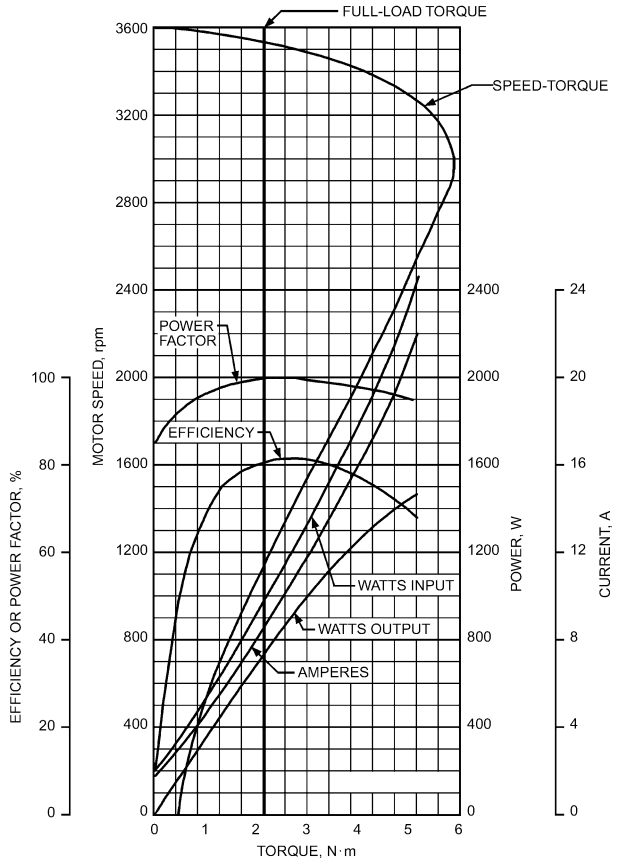


Fig. 3 Typical Performance Characteristics of Permanent Split-Capacitor Two-Pole Motor, 0.75 kW

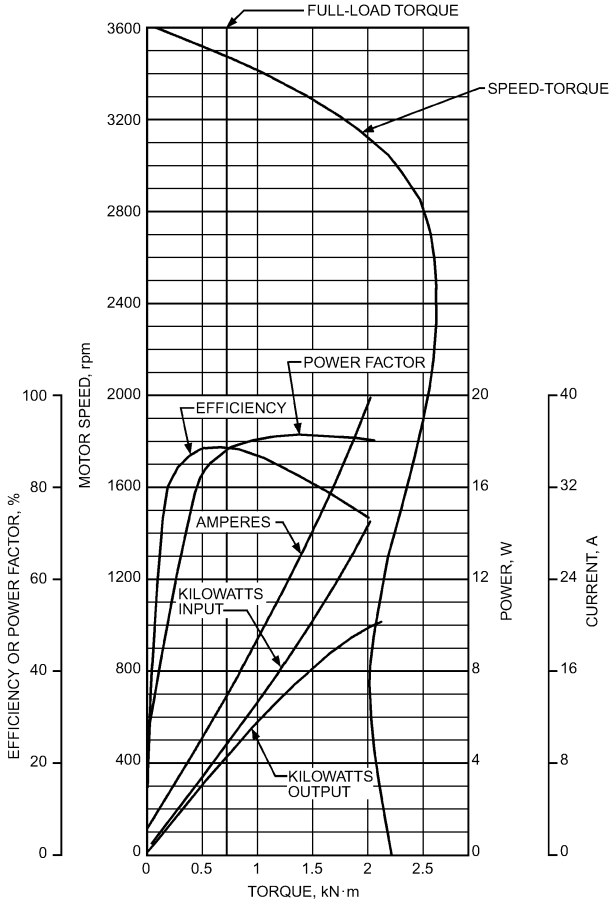


Fig. 4 Typical Performance Characteristics of Three-Phase Two-Pole Motor, 4 kW

tion, mounting, and space limitations; (2) speed range desired; (3) power requirement; (4) torque; (5) inertia; (6) frequency of starting; and (7) ventilation requirements. Motor characteristics that are frequently applied are generally presented in curves (see Figures 1 to 4).

Torque. The torque required to operate the driven machine at all times between initial breakaway and final shutdown is important in determining the type of motor. The torque available at zero speed or standstill (**starting torque**) may be less than 100% or as high as 400% of full-load torque, depending on motor design. The **starting current**, or **locked-rotor current**, is usually 400 to 600% of the current at rated full load.

Full-load torque is the torque developed to produce the rated power at the rated speed. **Full-load speed** also depends on the motor's design. For induction motors, a speed of 1750 rpm is typical for four-pole motors, and a speed of 3450 rpm is typical for two-pole motors at 60 Hz.

Motors have a **maximum** or **breakdown torque**, which cannot be exceeded. The relation between breakdown torque and full-load torque varies widely, depending on motor design.

Power. The power delivered by a motor is a product of its torque and speed. Because a given motor delivers increasing power up to maximum torque, a basis for power rating is needed. NEMA bases **power rating** on breakdown torque limits for single-phase motors, 7.5 kW and less. All others are rated at their power capacity within voltage and temperature limits as listed by NEMA.

Full-load rating is based on the maximum winding temperature. If the nameplate marking includes the maximum ambient temperature for which the motor is designed and the insulation designation, the maximum temperature rise of the winding may be determined from the appropriate section of NEMA *Standard* MG 1.

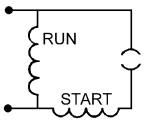
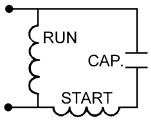
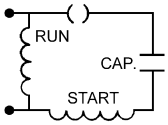
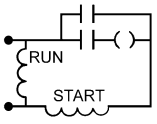
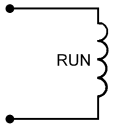
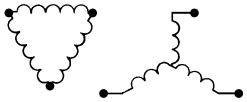
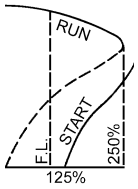
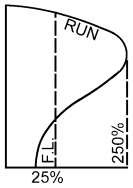
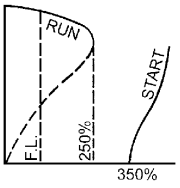
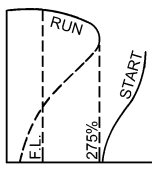
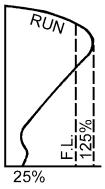
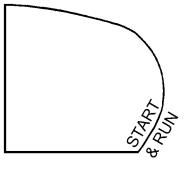
Service Factor. This factor is the maximum overload that can be applied to general-purpose motors and certain definite-purpose motors without exceeding the temperature limitation of the insulation. When the voltage and frequency are maintained at the values specified on the nameplate and the ambient temperature does not exceed 40°C, the motor may be loaded to the power obtained by multiplying the rated power by the service factor shown on the nameplate. Operating a motor continuously at service factor loading reduces insulation and bearing life compared to operation within the load rating.

The power rating is normally established on the basis of a test-run in still air. However, most direct-drive, air-moving applications are checked with air flowing over the motor. If the motor nameplate marking does not specify a service factor, refer to the appropriate section of NEMA *Standard* MG 1. Characteristics of alternating current motors are given in Table 4.

1.5 PERMANENT-MAGNET AC MOTORS

Permanent-magnet AC motors, often referred to as brushless, differ from standard induction motors by their rotors, which contain permanent magnets, either surface mounted or internal to the rotor. Permanent-magnet motors are more efficient than induction motors because they do not need to induce a magnetic field in the rotor to follow the rotating magnet field in the stator. Also, because of their flatter efficiency curve, these motors can maintain higher efficiency at low loads compared to induction motors. However, permanent-

Table 4 Characteristics of AC Motors (Nonhermetic)

	Split-Phase	Permanent Split-Capacitor	Capacitor-Start/ Induction-Run	Capacitor-Start/ Capacitor-Run	Shaded-Pole	Three Phase
Connection Diagram						
Typical Speed Torque Curves						
Starting Method	Centrifugal switch	None	Centrifugal switch	Centrifugal switch	None	None
Ratings, kW	0.04 to 0.4	0.04 to 3.7	0.04 to 3.7	0.04 to 3.7	0.007 to 0.19	0.4 and up
Approximate Full-Load Speeds at 60 Hz (Two-Pole/Four-Pole)	3450/1725	3450/1725	3450/1725	3500/1750	3100/1550	3500/1750
Torque*						
Locked Rotor	125 to 150%	30 to 150%	250 to 350%	250%	25%	150 to 350%
Breakdown	250 to 300%	250 to 300%	250 to 300%	250%	125%	250 to 350%
Speed Classification	Constant	Constant	Constant	Constant	Constant or adjustable	Constant
Full-Load Power Factor	60%	95%	65%	95%	60%	80%
Efficiency	Medium	High	Medium	High	Low	High-Medium

*Expressed as percent of rated power torque.

magnet motors cannot be started by simply applying AC line power. To operate properly, these motors must always be applied with a suitable variable-frequency drive. Sometimes, the variable-frequency drive is integrated with the motor.

1.6 HERMETIC MOTORS

A hermetic motor is a partial motor usually consisting of a stator and a rotor without shaft, end shields, or bearings. It is for installation in hermetically sealed refrigeration compressor units. With the motor and compressor sealed in a common chamber, the winding insulation system must be impervious to the action of the refrigerant and lubricating oil. Hermetic motors are used in both welded and accessible hermetic (semihermetic) compressors.

Application

Domestic Refrigeration. Hermetic motors up to 0.25 kW are used. They are split-phase, permanent split-capacitor, or capacitor-start motors for medium- or low-starting-torque compressors and capacitor-start and special split-phase motors for high-starting-torque compressors.

Room Air Conditioners. Motors from 0.25 to 2.2 kW are used. They are permanent split-capacitor or capacitor-start/capacitor-run types. These designs have high power factor and efficiency and meet the need for low current draw, particularly on 115 V circuits.

Central Air Conditioning (Including Heat Pumps). Both single-phase (4.5 kW and below) and three-phase (1.1 kW and above) motors are used. The single-phase motors are permanent split-capacitor or capacitor-start/capacitor-run types.

Small Commercial Refrigeration. Practically all these units are below 3.7 kW, with single-phase being the most common. Capacitor-start/induction-run motors are normally used up to 0.6 kW because of starting torque requirements. Capacitor-start/capacitor-run motors are used for larger sizes because they provide high starting torque and high full-load efficiency and power factor.

Large Commercial Refrigeration. Most motors are three-phase and larger than 3.7 kW.

Power ratings of motors for hermetic compressors do not necessarily have a direct relationship to the thermodynamic output of a compressor. Designs are tailored to match the compressor characteristics and specific applications. Chapter 38 briefly discusses hermetic motor applications for various compressors.

1.7 INTEGRAL THERMAL PROTECTION

The *National Electrical Code* (NEC) and UL standards cover motor protection requirements. Separate, external protection devices include the following:

Thermal Protectors. These protective devices are an integral part of a motor or hermetic motor refrigerant compressor. They protect the motor against overheating caused by overload, failure to start, or excessive operating current. Thermal protectors are required to protect three-phase motors from overheating because of an open phase in the primary circuit of the supply transformer. Thermal protection is accomplished by either a line break device or a thermal sensing control circuit.

The protector of a hermetic motor-compressor has some unique capabilities compared to nonhermetic motor protectors. The refrigerant cools the motor and compressor, so the thermal protector may be required to prevent overheating from loss of refrigerant charge, low suction pressure and high superheat at the compressor, obstructed suction line, or malfunction of the condensing means.

Article 440 of the NEC limits the maximum continuous current on a motor-compressor to 156% of rated load current if an integral thermal protector is used. NEC Article 430 limits the maximum

continuous current on a nonhermetic motor to different percentages of full-load current as a function of size. If separate overload relays and fuses are used for protection, Article 430 limits maximum continuous current to 140% and 125%, respectively, of rated load.

UL *Standard* 984 specifies that the compressor enclosure must not exceed 150°C under any conditions. The motor winding temperature limit is set by the compressor manufacturer based on individual compressor design requirements.

Line-Break Protectors. Integral with a motor or motor-compressor, line-break thermal protectors that sense both current and temperature are connected electrically in series with the motor; their contacts interrupt the total motor line-current. These protectors are used in small, single-phase and three-phase motors up through 11 kW.

Protectors installed inside a motor-compressor are hermetically sealed because exposed arcing in the presence of refrigerant cannot be tolerated. They provide better protection than the external type for loss of charge, obstructed suction line, or low voltage on the stalled rotor. This is because of low current associated with these fault conditions, hence the need to sense the motor temperature increase by thermal contact. Protection inside the compressor housing must withstand pressure requirements established by UL.

Protectors mounted externally on motor-compressor shells, sensing only shell temperature and line current, are typically used on smaller compressors, such as those in household refrigerators and small room air conditioners. One benefit occurs during high-head-pressure starting conditions, which can occur if voltage is lost momentarily or if the user inadvertently turns off the compressor with the temperature control and then turns it back on immediately. Usually, these units do not start under these conditions. When this happens, the protector takes the unit off the line and resets automatically when the compressor cools and pressures have equalized to a level that allows the compressor to start.

Protectors installed in nonhermetic motors may be attached to the stator windings or may be mounted off the windings but in the motor housing. Those protectors placed on the winding are generally installed before stator varnish dip and bake, and their construction must prevent varnish from entering the contact chamber.

Because the protector carries full motor line current, its size is based on adequate contact capability to interrupt the stalled current of the motor on continuous cycling for periods specified in UL *Standard* 984.

The compressor or motor manufacturer applies and selects appropriate motor protection in cooperation with the protector manufacturer. Any change in protector rating, by other than the specifying manufacturer after the proper application has been made, may result in either overprotection and frequent nuisance tripouts or underprotection and burnout of the motor windings. Connections to protector terminals, including lead wire sizes, should not be changed, and no additional connections should be made to the terminals. Any change in connection changes the terminal conditions and affects protector performance.

Control Circuit Protectors. Protection systems approved for use with a motor or motor-compressor, either sensing both current and temperature or sensing temperature only, are used with 1 kW and larger single-phase and three-phase motors.

The current and temperature protector uses a bimetallic temperature sensor installed in the motor winding in conjunction with thermal overload relays. The sensors are connected in series with the control circuit of a magnetic contactor that interrupts the motor current. Thermostat sensors of this type, which depend on their size and mass, are capable of tracking motor winding temperature for running overloads. When a rotor is locked (when the rate of change in winding temperature is rapid), the temperature lag is usually too great for such sensors to provide protection when they are used alone. However, when the bimetallic sensor is used with separate thermal overload or magnetic time-delay relays that sense motor current, the combination provides excellent protection. On a locked rotor condition, the current-sensing relay protects for the initial cycle, and the combined functioning of relay and thermostat protects for subsequent cycles.

The temperature-only protector uses the resistance change of a thermistor-type sensor to provide a switching signal to an electronic circuit, whose output is in series with the control circuit of a magnetic contactor used to interrupt the motor current. The output of the electronic protection circuitry (module) may be an electromechanical relay or a power triac. The sensors may be installed directly on the stator winding end turns or buried inside the windings. Their small size and good thermal transfer allow them to track the temperature of the winding for locked rotor, as well as running overload.

Three types of sensors are available. One type uses a ceramic material with a positive temperature coefficient of resistance; the material exhibits a large, abrupt change in resistance at a particular design temperature. This change occurs at the **anomaly point**, which is inherent in the sensor. The anomaly point remains constant once the sensor is manufactured; sensors are produced with anomaly points at different temperatures to meet different requirements. However, a single module calibration can be supplied for all anomaly temperatures of a given sensor type.

Another type of sensor uses a metal wire, which has a linear increase in resistance with temperature. The sensor assumes a specified value of resistance corresponding to each desired value of response or operating temperature. It is used with an electronic protection module calibrated to a specific resistance. Modules supplied with different calibrations are used to achieve various values of operating temperatures.

A third type is a negative temperature coefficient of resistance sensor, which is integrated with electronic circuitry similar to that used with the metal wire sensor.

More than one sensor may be connected to a single electronic module in parallel or series, depending on design. However, the sensors and modules must be of the same design and intended for use with the particular number of sensors installed and the wiring method used. Electronic protection modules must be paired only with sensors specified by the manufacturer, unless specific equivalency is established and identified by the motor or compressor manufacturer.

1.8 MOTOR PROTECTION AND CONTROL

In general, four functions are accomplished by motor protection and control. Separate or integral control components are provided to (1) disconnect the motor and controller from the power supply and protect the operator; (2) start and stop the motor and, in some applications, control the speed or direction of rotation; (3) protect motor branch circuit conductors and control apparatus against short-circuiting; and (4) protect the motor itself from overloading and overheating.

Separate Motor Protection

Most air-conditioning and refrigeration motors or motor-compressors, whether open or hermetic, are equipped with integral motor protection by the equipment manufacturer. If this is not the case, separate motor-protection devices, sensing current only, must be used. These consist of thermal or magnetic relays, similar to those used in industrial control, that provide running overload and stalled-rotor protection. Because hermetic motor windings heat rapidly because of the loss of the cooling effect of refrigerant gas flow when the rotor is stalled, **quick-trip devices** must be used.

Thermostats or **thermal devices** are sometimes used to supplement current-sensing devices. Supplements are necessary (1) when automatic restarting is required after trip or (2) to protect from

abnormal running conditions that do not increase motor current. These devices are discussed in the section on Integral Thermal Protection.

Protection of Control Apparatus and Branch Circuit Conductors

In addition to protection of the motor itself, Articles 430 and 440 of the *National Electrical Code* require the control apparatus and branch circuit conductors to be protected from overcurrent resulting from motor overload or failure to start. This protection can be given by some thermal protective systems that do not allow a continuous current in excess of required limits. In other cases, a current-sensing device, such as an overload relay, a fuse, or a circuit breaker, is used.

Circuit Breakers. These devices are used for disconnecting as well as circuit protection, and are available in ratings for use with small household refrigerators as well as in large commercial and industrial installations. Manual switches for disconnecting and fuses for short-circuit protection are also used. For single-phase motors up to 2.2 kW, 230 V, an attachment plug is an acceptable disconnecting device.

Controllers. The motor control used is determined by the size and type of motor, power supply, and degree of automation. Control may be manual, semiautomatic, or fully automatic.

Central air conditioners are generally located some distance from the controlled space environment control, such as room thermostats. Therefore, **magnetic controllers** must be used in these installations. Also, all DC and all large AC installations must be equipped with in-rush **current-limiting controllers**, which are discussed later. **Synchronous motors** are sometimes used to improve the power factor. **Multispeed motors** provide flexibility for many applications.

Manual Control. For an AC or DC motor, manual control is usually located near the motor. If so, an operator must be present to start and stop or change the motor speed by adjusting the control mechanism.

Manual control is the simplest and least expensive control method for small AC motors, both single-phase and three-phase, but it is seldom used with hermetic motors. The manual controller usually consists of a set of main line contacts, which are provided with thermal overload relays for motor protection.

Manual speed controllers can be used for large air conditioners using **slip-ring motors**; they may also provide reduced-current starting. Different speed points are used to vary the amount of cooling provided by the compressor.

Across-the-Line Magnetic Controllers. These controllers are widely used for central air conditioning. They may be applied to motors of all sizes, provided power supply and motor are suitable to this type of control. Across-the-line magnetic starters may be used with automatic control devices for starting and stopping. Where push buttons are used, they may be wired for either low-voltage release or low-voltage protection.

Three-Phase Motor Starting

One advantage of three-phase induction motors is their inherently good starting torque without special coils or components. However, some applications require current reduction or additional starting torque.

Full-Voltage and Reduced-Voltage Starting. For motors, full-voltage starting is commonly used because of its lower initial cost and simplicity of control. Except for DC machines, most motors are mechanically and electrically designed for full-voltage starting. The maximum allowable starting current, however, is limited in many cases by power utility requirements made because of voltage fluctuations, which may be caused by heavy current surges. Therefore, to meet the limitations of available power supplies, the starting current must often be reduced below that obtained by across-the-line starting. Many alternative methods have been applied to accomplish this.

Primary Resistance Starting. This method is one of the simplest ways to make this reduction, with resistors placed in the primary circuit. As the motor accelerates, the resistance is cut out by the use of timing or current relays.

Autotransformer Motor Starters. In this method, starting voltage is reduced, and, when the motor accelerates, it is disconnected from the transformer and connected across the line by timing or current relays. Primary resistor starters are generally smaller and less expensive than autotransformer starters for moderate size motors; however, primary resistor starters require more line current for a given starting torque.

Solid-State Electronic Soft Starters. These starters can ramp the supply voltage at preprogrammed rates to reduce in-rush current and provide optimum torque for each application. This method has become widely accepted because of the reliability of power electronics and the electronic capability to program acceleration and deceleration ramp times. Current limit may also be used with this motor starting method. Once the motor reaches full speed, bypass contactors may be used to remove power electronic devices used during the motor start.

Star-Delta (Wye Delta) Motor Starters. This starting method limits current efficiently, but these starters require motors configured with extra windings and leads for this type of starting. The motor is started with its windings connected in a star (wye) configuration. This increases the line-to-line impedance of the motor, reducing its starting current. After a time delay, a set of contactors reconfigures the motor's windings into a delta configuration. This allows the motor to produce its full rated output. They are particularly suited for centrifugal, rotary screw, and reciprocating compressor drives starting without load.

Part-Winding Motor Starters. These starters limit line disturbances by connecting only part of the motor winding to the line and connecting the second motor winding to the line after a time interval of 1 to 3 s. If the motor is not heavily loaded, it accelerates when the first part of the winding is connected to the line; if it is too heavily loaded, the motor may not start until the second winding is connected to the line. In either case, the voltage sag is less than the sag that would result if a standard squirrel-cage motor with an across-the-line starter were used. Part-winding motors may be controlled either manually or magnetically. The magnetic controller consists of two contactors and a timing device for the second contactor.

Multispeed Motor Starters. Multispeed motors provide flexibility in many types of drives in which variation in capacity is needed. Two types of multispeed motors are used: (1) motors with one reconnectable winding and (2) motors with two separate windings. Motors with separate windings need a contactor for each winding, and only one contactor can be closed at any time. Motors with a reconnectable winding are similar to motors with two windings, but the contactors and motor circuits are different.

Slip-Ring Motor Starters. Slip-ring AC motors provide reduced-current starting with high torque during acceleration and variable speed after acceleration. The wound rotor of these motors functions in the same manner as in the squirrel-cage motor, except that the rotor windings are connected through slip rings and brushes to external circuits with resistance to vary the motor speed. Increasing resistance in the rotor circuit reduces motor speed, and decreasing resistance increases motor speed. When resistance is shorted out, the motor operates with maximum speed, efficiency, and power factor. On some large installations, manual drum controllers are used as speed-setting devices. Complete automatic control can be provided with special control devices for selecting motor speeds. Operation at reduced speed is at reduced efficiency. These controllers have become less common with the advent of variable-frequency drives,

which provide low-current, high-torque starting with good efficiency at reduced speed.

Direct-Current Motor Starting

These motors have constant torque characteristics, and their speed can be precisely controlled by varying voltage in the field, armature, or both. Large DC motors are started with resistance in the armature circuit, which is reduced step by step until the motor reaches its base speed. Higher speeds are provided by weakening the motor field. These systems are becoming less common as better speed control strategies in AC motor drive systems develop.

Single-Phase Motor Starting

Motor-starting switches and relays for single-phase motors must provide a means for disconnecting the starting winding of split-phase or capacitor-start/induction-run motors or the start capacitor of capacitor-start/capacitor-run motors. Motors may have a centrifugal switch mounted on the motor shaft, which disconnects the starting winding at about 70% of full-load speed.

Thermally Operated Relay. When the motor is started, a contact that is normally closed applies power to the starting winding. A thermal element that controls these contacts is in series with the motor and carries line current. Current flowing through this element heats it until, after a definite time, it is warmed sufficiently to open the contacts and remove power from the starting winding. The running current then heats the element enough to keep the contacts open. Setting the time for the starting contacts to open is determined by tests on the components (i.e., the relay, motor, and compressor) and is based on a prediction of the time delay required to bring the motor up to speed.

An alternative form of a thermally operated relay is a positive temperature coefficient of resistance (PTC) starting device. This device has a ceramic element with low resistance at room temperature that increases about 1000 times when it is heated to a predetermined temperature. It is placed in series with the start winding of split-phase motors and allows current flow when power is applied. After a definite period, the self-heating of the PTC resistive element causes it to reach its high-resistance state, which reduces current flow in the start winding. The small residual current maintains the PTC element in the high-resistance state while the motor is running. A PTC starting device may also be connected in parallel with a run capacitor, and the combination may be connected in series with the starting winding. It allows the motor to start like a split-phase motor and then, when the PTC element reaches the high-resistance state, operate as a capacitor-run motor. When power is removed, the PTC element must be allowed to cool to its low resistance state before restarting the motor.

Current-Operated Relay. In this type of connection, a relay coil carries the line current going to the motor. When the motor is started, the in-rush current to the running winding passes through the relay coil, causes the normally open contacts to close, and applies power to the starting winding. As the motor comes up to speed, the current decreases until, at a definite calibrated value of current corresponding to a preselected speed, the magnetic force of the coil diminishes to a point that allows the contacts to open to remove power from the starting winding. This relay takes advantage of the **main winding current** as opposed to the **speed** characteristics of the motor. The current/speed curve varies with line voltage, so the starting relay must be selected for the voltage range likely to be encountered in service. Ratings established by the manufacturer should not be changed because this may result in undesirable starting characteristics. They are selected to disconnect the starting winding or start capacitor at approximately 70 to 90% of synchronous speed for four-pole motors.

Voltage-Operated Relay. Capacitor-start and capacitor-start/capacitor-run hermetically sealed motors above 0.4 kW are usually started with a normally closed contact voltage relay. In this method of starting, the relay coil is connected in parallel with the starting winding. When power is applied to the motor, the relay does not operate because it is calibrated to operate at a higher voltage. As the motor comes up to speed, the voltage across the starting winding and relay coil increases in proportion to the motor speed. At a definite voltage corresponding to a preselected speed, the relay opens; this opens the starting winding or disconnects the starting capacitor. The relay keeps these contacts open because sufficient voltage is induced in the starting winding when the motor is running to hold the relay in the open position.

Operating AC Induction Motors above Nameplate Speed Using Variable-Frequency Drives

Increasingly, variable-frequency drives (VFDs) are used to operate motors above nameplate speeds. This is done to increase the capacity of fans or pumps during normal operation or, sometimes, only during emergency peak demand situations (e.g., smoke evacuation). In either case, it is critical that these systems have properly sized motors to perform at the increased loads these speeds require.

Care is necessary when operating the motor at a frequency other than its nameplate frequency. The voltage applied to the motor must be adjusted along with the frequency. Supplying too much voltage can force too much current through the motor, generating excess heat. This reduces the motor's efficiency and could damage it. Applying too little voltage to the motor reduces its output torque capacity and causes the motor's slip to increase. This also increases the motor's current and thermal stress, even though its torque is reduced. This may cause the motor to stall when attempting to drive the connected load. Consideration should also be given to the maximum allowable speed of the load.

The ideal amount of voltage depends on both operating speed and amount of torque required by the load. Because most HVAC applications use drives on variable-torque loads, this section discusses only this type of load profile. Variable-torque loads require reduced torque at reduced operating speeds but also require increased torque as the speed is increased, even above base speed. In a pure variable-torque application, the torque required is proportional to the square of the load's speed. VFDs that are programmed for variable-torque applications often significantly reduce the voltage applied to the motor as its speed is reduced. Most now have added advanced control algorithms that allow them to go beyond simply controlling the voltage applied to the motor at any speed and instead try to reduce the current at any given load/speed condition.

Although operating a motor above its nameplate frequency would seem to be similar to operating it below its nameplate frequency, the situation is actually quite different, because at some point the drive runs out of additional voltage that can be applied to the motor. Standard VFDs only switch the supplied line voltage to obtain the output that the motor requires; they do not have the ability to significantly step up the power line voltage. As a result, the voltage applied to the motor stops increasing once it reaches rated, base speed. At the same time, the torque required by the driven load can increase significantly. Therefore, it is critical to properly size the motor and VFD to produce the torque which these speeds require.

Figure 5 shows a typical motor voltage versus frequency output for a variable-torque VFD and motor operating at up to 150% of the motor nameplate frequency.

Because the voltage applied to the motor is no longer enough to provide full magnetizing current, the output torque capacity of the motor is reduced above the 100% rated frequency. Figure 6 shows how, after passing the motor's rated frequency and voltage, the available torque from the motor drops. In Figure 6, increasing speed by 50% drops the motor's available torque to a bit less than 66% of

its full-load rating. Because power is torque × speed, this results in approximately the same output power capacity during this extended-frequency operation as was available at rated frequency. Output power available from the motor may drop slightly, because of additional losses in the motor at the higher output speed. In general, this relationship between output frequency and output power holds for VFD output frequencies up to twice the motor's base frequency.

To properly size the VFD and motor for extended-frequency control of variable-torque fans and pumps, it is important to remember that the load's power requirement increases approximately in proportion to the cube of its speed, but the motor's output power capacity may drop slightly as its speed increases above its rated speed. Therefore, it is essential to size the motor and VFD so that their base-speed power ratings are slightly greater than the power requirement of the load at the maximum extended frequency that will be used, as shown in Figure 7.

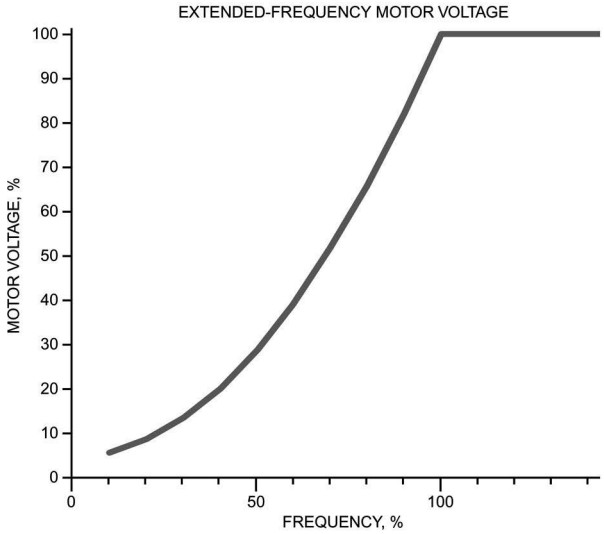


Fig. 5 Motor Voltage Versus Frequency

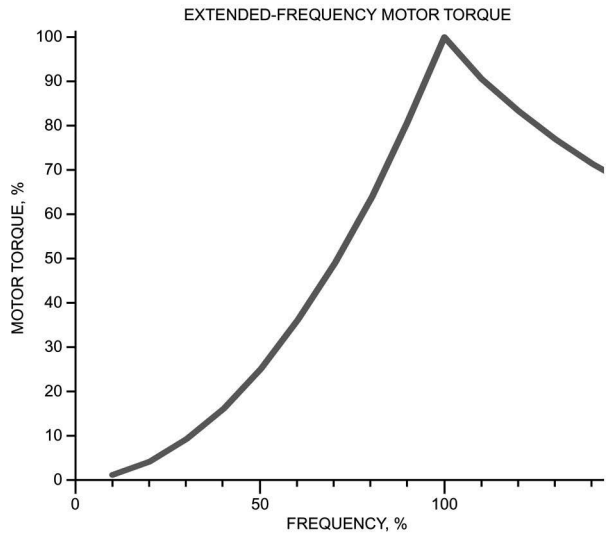


Fig. 6 Motor Torque Limits Versus Frequency

VFD-Induced Bearing Currents

Causes of Bearing Currents. Although motor bearing currents have been recognized since the 1920s, recent developments have increased their frequency of occurrences (and therefore concerns about them).

The following are major factors in the recent concern about motor bearing damage:

- Expanded use of pulse-width modulation (PWM) VFDs to control the speed of AC induction motors. Although PWM VFDs are very efficient and reliable, two aspects of them can contribute to motor bearing damage:
  - They convert incoming AC power into a DC bus. Energy from this DC bus is then switched to provide three-phase current to the driven motor. The AC power line can be symmetric with respect to earth ground, but it is very difficult to maintain this symmetry as the two polarities from the DC bus are switched to the three phases of the driven motor. This lack of symmetry results in common-mode voltages and currents being applied to the motor.
  - The PWM waveform consists of pulses of voltage from the DC bus that are used to control the voltage and frequency of the AC current applied to the motor. These pulses may have a frequency of 2 to 20 kHz or even higher; they also have a rise time of significantly less than 1 μs. This sharp voltage rise increases the efficiency of the VFD by reducing its switching losses, but it also results in high-frequency components in the PWM pulse that can capacitively couple an unbalanced voltage distribution onto the motor's rotor and so its shaft.

The PWM-generated voltage applied to the motor may affect the motor in three different ways:

- It may couple an AC voltage directly onto the motor's frame.
- It may drive a circulating AC current from one end of the shaft, through the bearing into the motor frame, through the bearing at the far end of the motor, and back into the shaft. This is seen primarily only in motors that are 75 kW and larger.
- It may capacitively couple a voltage with respect to ground onto the motor's shaft. If this voltage is high enough, it may arc across the capacitor formed by the races of the bearing, its rolling elements, and the lubricant, which acts as a dielectric.

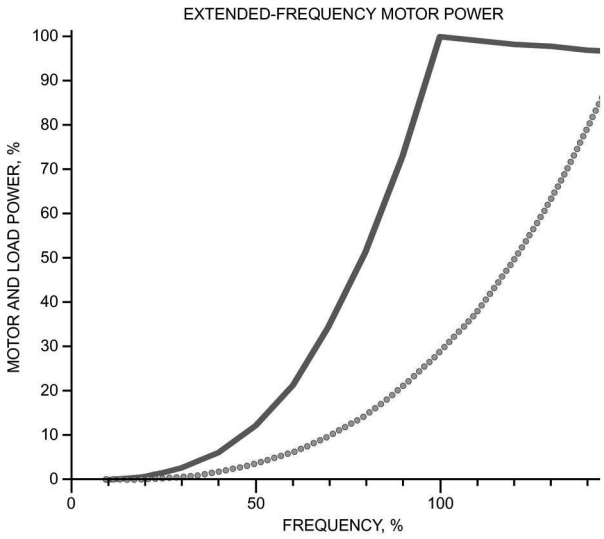


Fig. 7 Motor Power Capacity at Maximum Extended Frequency

Current pulsing across the bearing's lubricant will cause a minor mark in the bearing's races and/or its rolling elements. Although this damage will be minor at first, over time, these discharges may cause significant pitting or fluting of the bearing's races and/or its rolling elements (Figure 8).

Detecting Bearing Currents

The end result of prolonged arcing across a motor's bearings is increased vibration and audible noise. Therefore, detecting the presence of such discharges can be useful. In the field, it is nearly impossible to directly measure the discharge current through the bearing. However, there are two tests that can be performed to detect the presence of such discharges.

The first is to use a storage oscilloscope to record the voltage from the motor shaft to the motor's frame. The following equipment is needed:

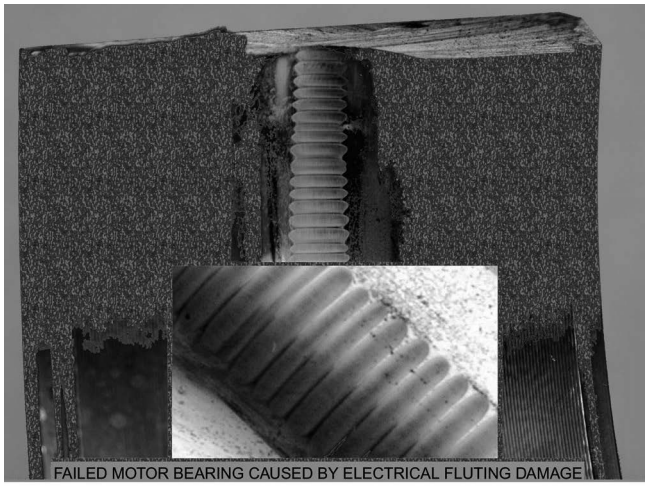


Fig. 8 Fluted Bearing from VFD-Induced Electrical Bearing Current Discharges

(Oh and Willwerth 2008)

- Digital storage oscilloscope with a bandwidth of at least 50 MHz
- Probe to contact the rotating motor shaft, such as
  - Commercially available probes
  - Carbon brush adapted to be held on the motor's shaft
  - Any other device that can be adapted to contact the rotating shaft while using a minimum of bare lead length, which may pick up stray electrical noise
- Magnetic mount stand or some other device to hold the shaft probe in place while measurements are made

Use the following procedure:

1. With the motor stopped, set up the measurement equipment.
2. Set up the oscilloscope similar to this:
   a. Direct current coupling.
   b. Trigger ON.
   c. Initial trigger level: approximately 2 V.
   d. Initial time base: with a minimum sampling rate of at least 10 µs/division.
   e. Vertical scale: approximately ±30 V full scale.
3. Start the motor and adjust the oscilloscope to see the voltage on the motor's shaft.
4. Increase the trigger level until the highest shaft voltage is shown.

If the shaft voltage increases and decreases relatively gradually, no discharges are occurring across the bearing (Figures 9 and 10). If the shaft voltage increases relatively gradually and then collapses quickly, a discharge across the bearing has been detected (Figures 11 and 12).

The second method requires no contact with the motor's shaft. It uses a commercially available device that uses an antenna to detect the signature radio frequency signature of a discharge across a bearing. The advantages of this method are that it (1) requires little setup, because it does not need to be in contact with the motor's shaft, and (2) can be used to count the number of discharges over a period of time. Its disadvantages are that (1) the user must be careful to avoid external noise sources that might appear to be discharges while placing the antenna in a good position to pick up actual shaft discharges, and (2) the meter does not indicate the peak value of the voltage on the motor's shaft.

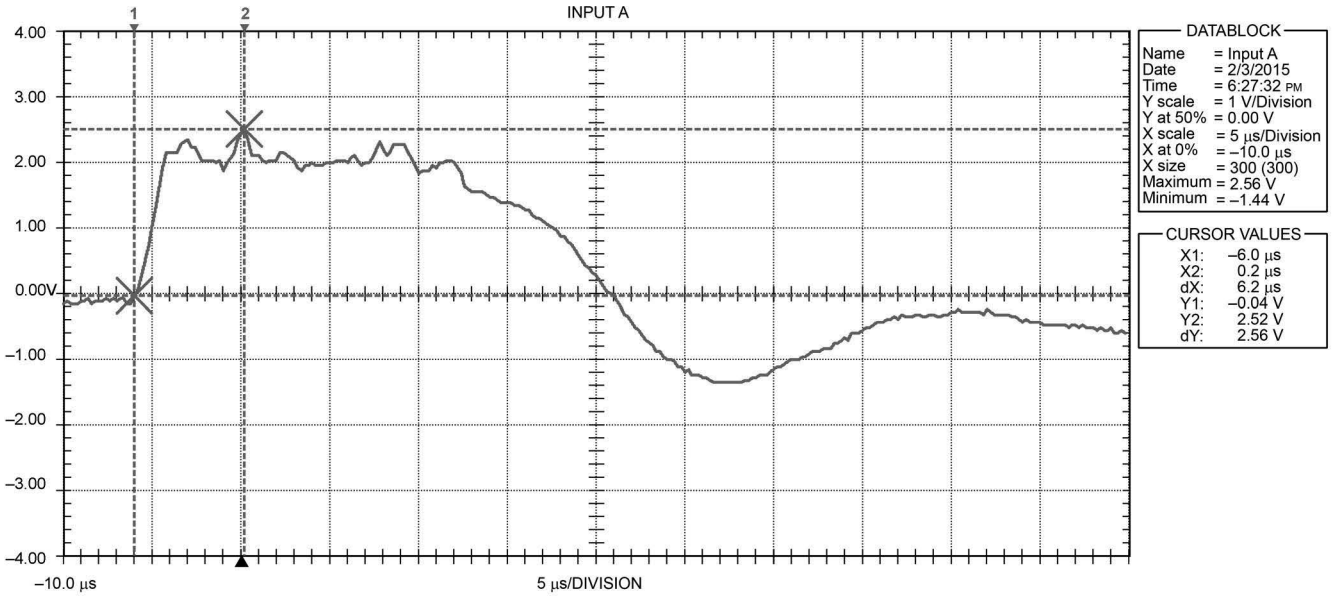


Fig. 9 2.5 V Peak Shaft Voltage, No Discharge

Strategies for Mitigating Bearing Currents

Motor bearing damage caused by the discharge of motor shaft voltage is not common, but it does occur on occasion when a PWM VFD is used to control the speed of the motor. This section describes actions that can be taken to reduce the likelihood of encountering such discharges and damage.

System Installation. Because of the use of high-voltage pulses to control the speed of the driven motor, it is important to take care when wiring the drive/motor system. Because common-mode voltages and currents are often the cause of the induced shaft voltage, wiring techniques that reduce their impact on the motor are important. These include the following:

- Providing a low-impedance ground at the motor for the high-frequency components in the VFD's output.
- Routing the motor cables and ground wire inside a continuous metallic shield or conduit. This is done to provide a low-impedance return path to the VFD for the common-mode current that the motor receives. If such a path is not provided, the common-mode current will attempt to return to the VFD through any other available paths. These may include paths through the motor's bearings. To ensure a low impedance path,
  - If conduit is used, care must be taken to provide a reliable electrical bonding between sections of conduit.
  - Ideally, the ground wire to the motor should be a gage comparable with the gage of the motor leads and should have a high strand count. This is done to maximize the surface area of the ground wire in recognition of the fact that high-frequency currents tend to flow along the outside of a wire.

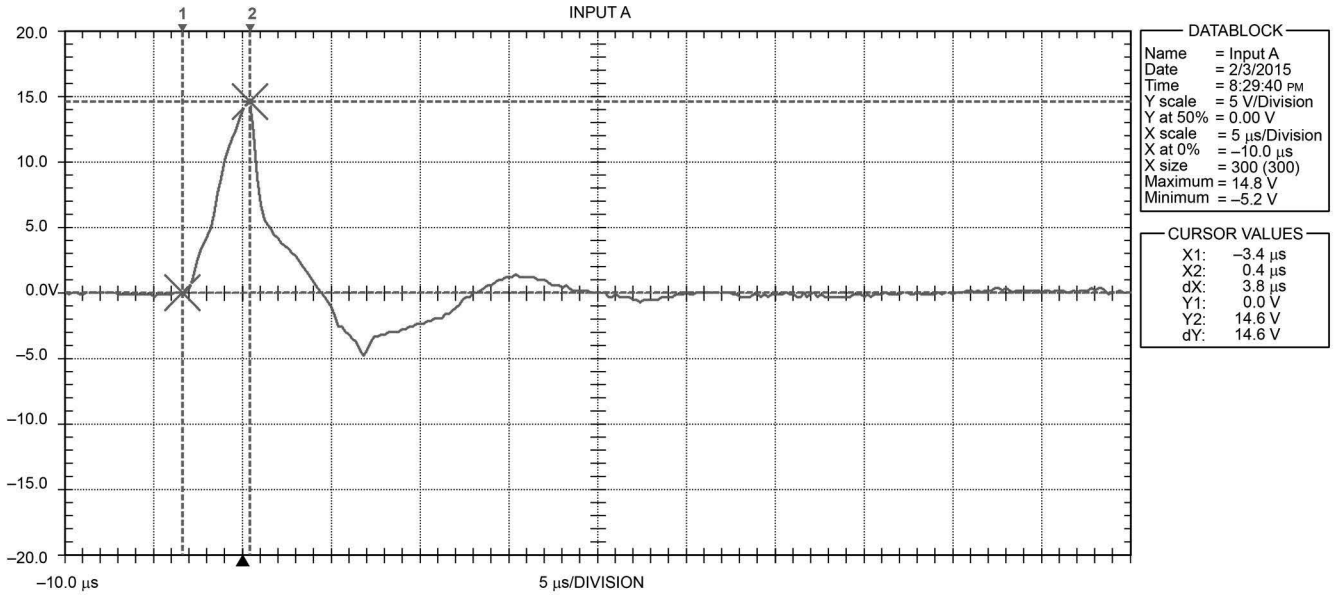


Fig. 10 14.6 V Peak Shaft Voltage, No Discharge

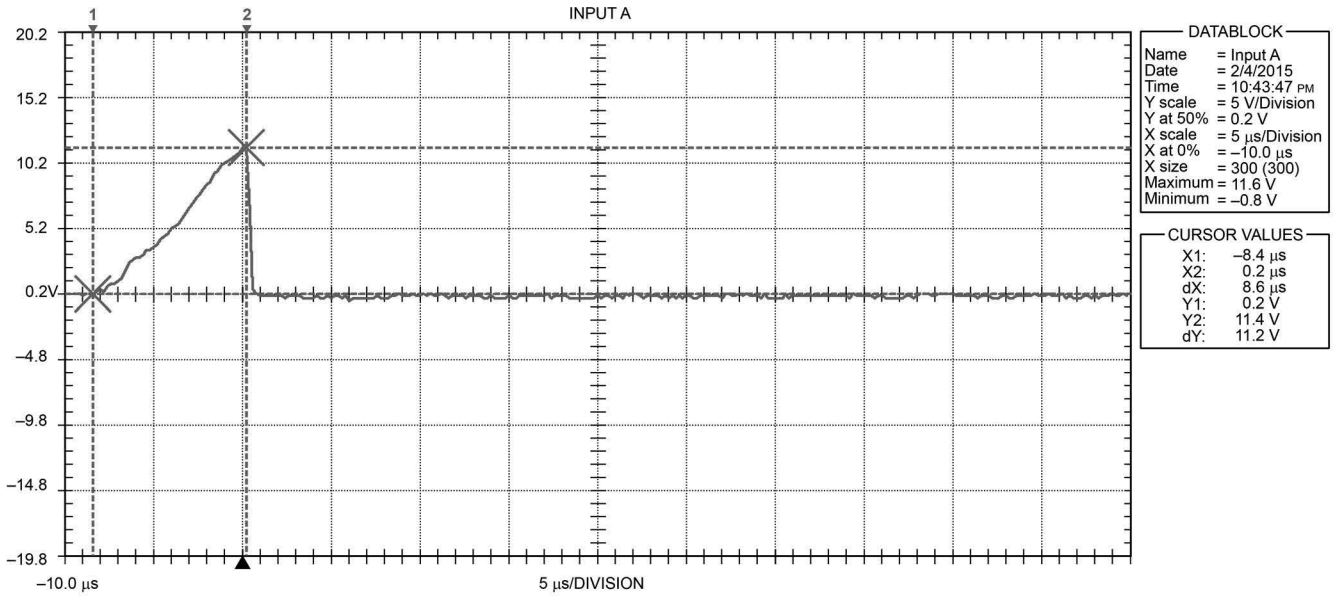


Fig. 11 11.4 V Peak Shaft Voltage, Discharge Detected

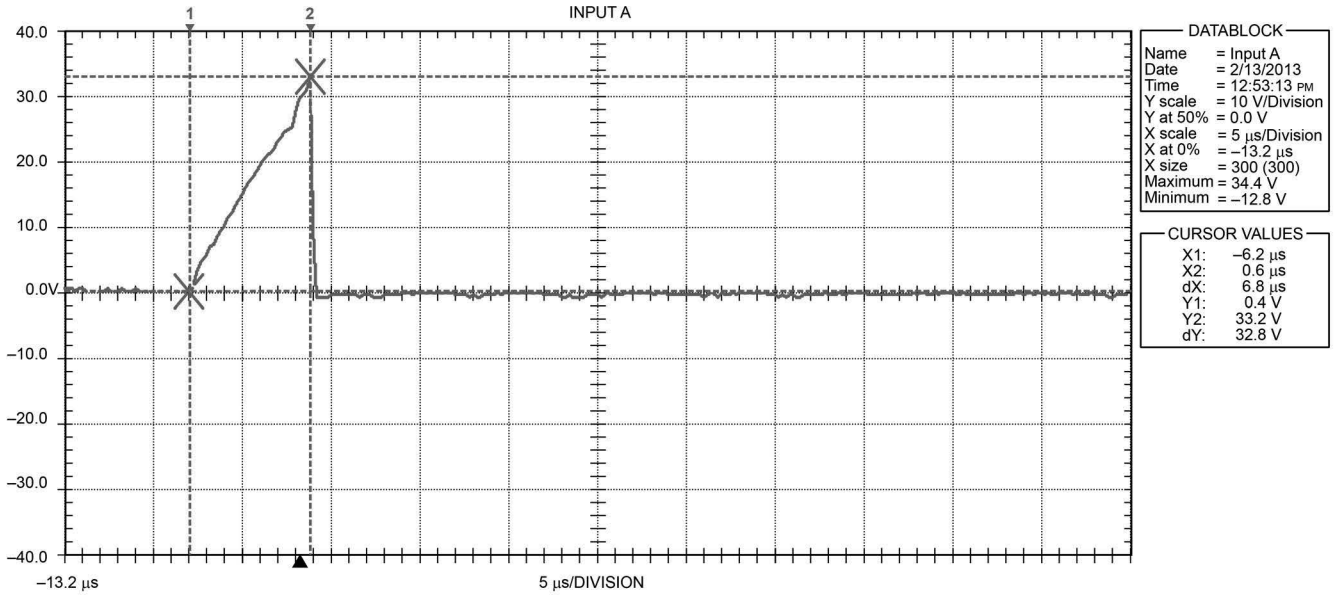


Fig. 12 32.2 V Peak Shaft Voltage, Discharge Detected

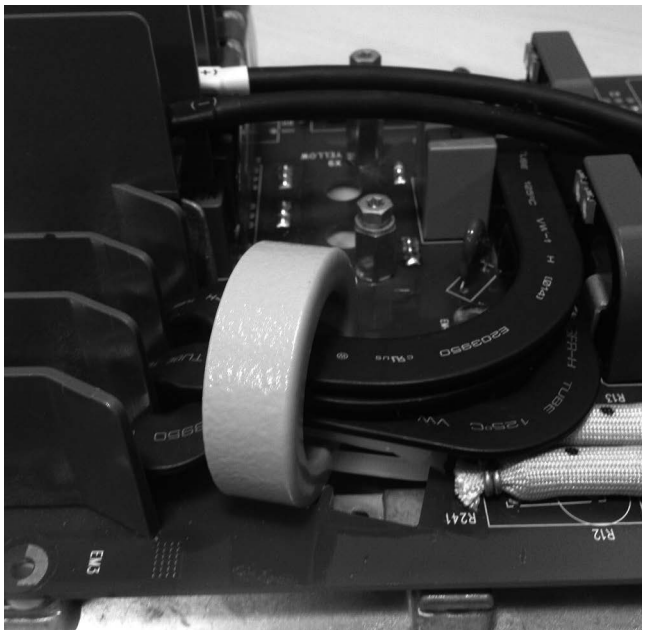


Fig. 13 Common Mode Toroid Built into Output of VFD

- The conduit or other shield should be solidly bonded to both the VFD's and the motor's frame. It may be necessary to remove paint at the conduit connections to ensure a good electrical connection.
- Providing low-impedance ground connection at the VFD.

Following these wiring practices will reduce not only the opportunities for motor bearing damage, but also the amount of high-frequency common mode noise (radio frequency interference [RF])/electromagnetic interference [EMI]) that may be conducted through the building's electrical power grid or be radiated from the VFD or the equipment that is connected to it.

Common-Mode Filters. The recommendations in the System Installation section are intended to divert the high-frequency, common-mode component of the VFD's PWM output from taking a return path through the motor's bearings. Common-mode filters mounted near the output of the VFD act to reduce the amplitude of the common-mode component of the VFD's output. Common-mode filters can be included as a part of an output filter. They can also take the form of a ferrite toroid that is placed around the three output motor leads from the VFD (Figure 13). In some cases, these are built into the VFD, although they are also available in a variety of sizes for retrofitting into existing applications.

Fig. 14 Typical Common-Mode Toroids for Retrofitting into Output of VFD

Common-mode filters should not be considered to be a replacement for the preceding system installation guidelines. They should instead be viewed as being a supplement to them.

A **Faraday shield** may be used as a conductive shield between the rotor and stator of the motor. It is used to reduce the capacitive coupling of voltage onto the motor's shaft. Although this is effective against capacitively coupled shaft voltage, it has little impact on circulating currents in the motor. The Faraday shield cannot be retrofitted in the field, has a significant impact on the cost of the motor, and may reduce the motor's efficiency.

Insulating Motor Bearings. Electrically insulating a motor's bearings blocks the path of current through the bearing. Because the induced voltage on a motor's shaft is quite low, the insulating material does not require a high dielectric strength. This can be accomplished in a variety of ways, including the following:

- Machining the motor's housing to allow room for a ring of insulating material to be installed between the bearing's outer race and the motor's bearing holder. This remains effective as long as the insulator does not break down or conductive dirt does not bridge the insulation. A concern about this method is the need to make the required modifications to the motor.
- Standard-dimensioned bearings with an insulated coating are available from some bearing manufacturers. This eliminates the need to modify the motor's housing. Such bearings are not presently available in all sizes used in motors.
- The rolling element of the bearing can be replaced by a nonconducting material, such as ceramic. When considering this solution, the load and service life rating of the bearing should be compared against the requirements of the application. Using different materials, such as ceramic bearings, can offer other benefits, such as increased mechanical life.

Insulating the motor's bearings is most appropriate for applications such as motor-shaft-mounted fans, which are not connected to other bearing-mounted shafts. If the motor is connected to equipment that contains its own shaft bearings, insulating the motor's bearings may simply move the bearing damage from the motor to the driven equipment. In such cases, it may be necessary to provide an insulated coupling between the motor and the driven equipment. It may also be advisable to bond the frame of the motor to the frame of the driven equipment using a grounding strap.

Although insulating just one of the motor's bearings may be effective in interrupting a circulating current along the length of the motor, doing this when the voltage is capacitively coupled to the motor's shaft will simply cause the noninsulated motor bearing to fail.

Motor Shaft Grounding. This method provides a low-impedance path around the motor's bearings, allowing the shaft voltage to discharge to the motor's frame without damaging its bearings.

One method that had been considered was to use electrically **conductive grease** in the motor's bearings. While this seemed promising, the conductive particles in the lubricant tended to increase mechanical wear in the motor's bearings. As a result, this method has largely been abandoned.

Several methods are based on using a device that mechanically contacts the motor's shaft and provides an electrical connection between it and the motor's frame. The following are examples of this approach:

- Rotary contact that is axially mounted at the opposite-drive end (ODE) of the motor's shaft
- Carbon brush that makes radial contact to the motor's shaft
- Metal brush that can be used in various configurations
- Conductive fiber brush that makes radial contact to the motor's shaft as shown in Figure 15 through a series of brushes or a continuous ring of brushes

When considering a shaft-grounding solution, the following aspects should be considered *for each specific application*:

- Surface preparation for the motor's shaft that is recommended by the device's manufacturer
- Ease of mounting the device onto the motor
- Compatibility of the device with the application's environment
- Recommended periodic maintenance and the ease of performing it

Combination solutions, such as insulating one bearing in a motor and using shaft grounding at the other side of the motor, may be recommended in certain applications. When multiple layers of protection are desired, such as for a hermetic-motor-driven chiller, more than one solution may also be applied. In all cases, avoiding motor bearing damage should always begin with ensuring the proper installation and wiring of the VFD/motor system.

Fig. 15 Shaft Grounding Ring Installed on Motor

(Oh and Willwerth 2008)

2. AIR VOLUME CONTROL

This section uses fan and air volume control as an example, but the same principles apply to centrifugal pumps and compressors.

The fan laws (Chapter 21) show that volume delivered by a fan is directly proportional to its speed, pressure is proportional to the square of the speed, and impeller shaft power is proportional to the cube of the speed. According to these laws, a fan operating at 50% volume requires only 12.5% of the impeller shaft power required at 100% volume.

Although the fan in a variable-air-volume (VAV) system is sized to handle peak volume, the system operates at reduced volume most of the time. For example, Figure 16 shows the volume levels of a typical VAV system operating below 70% volume over 87% of the time. Thus, adjustable-speed operation of the fan for this duty cycle could provide a significant energy saving.

Following is an example of a centrifugal fan driven by fixed-speed AC motor; air volume is varied by an outlet damper, variable inlet guide vanes, or an eddy current coupling.

An **outlet damper** is mounted on the fan outlet. Closing the damper reduces the volume at the expense of increased pressure. The design operating point corresponds to a wide-open damper position (point A). Points B and C on the fan performance curve in Figure 17 show the modified operating points for two partially closed damper positions. The input power to the impeller shaft is also shown for the referenced points.

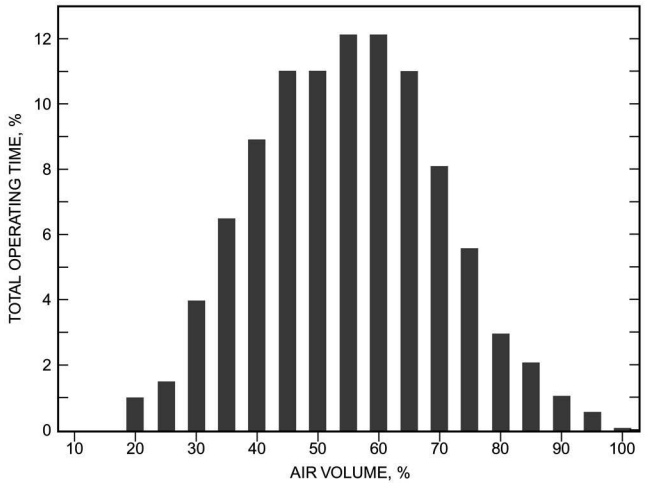


Fig. 16 Fan Duty Cycle for a VAV System

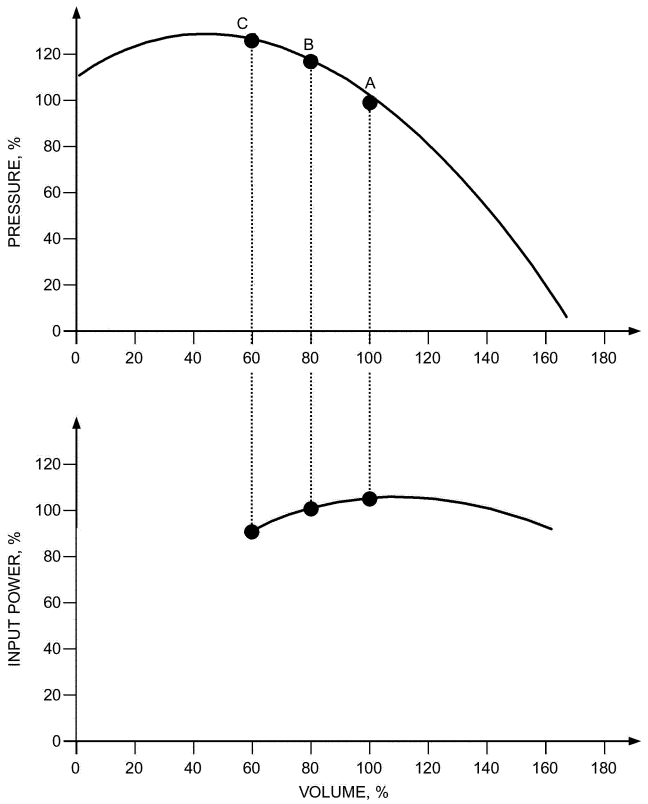


Fig. 17 Outlet Damper Control

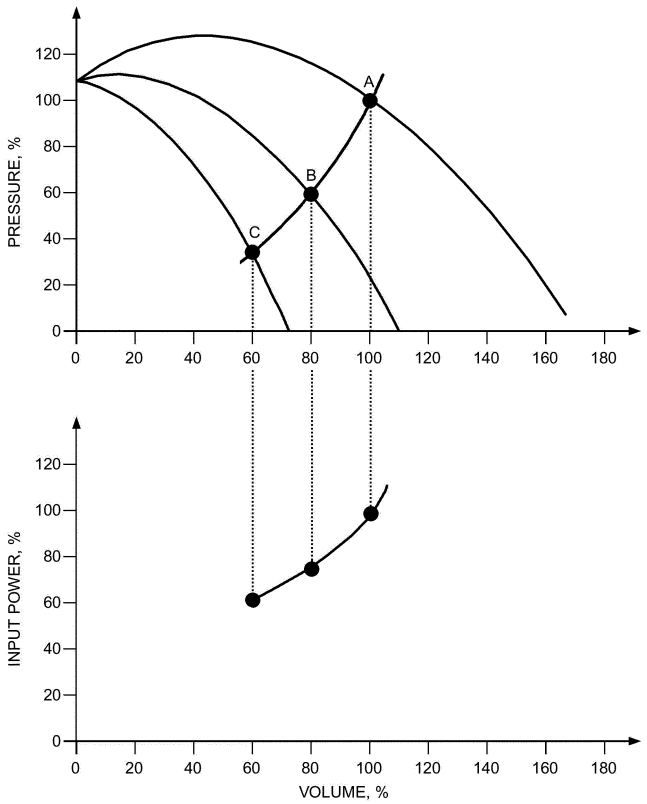


Fig. 18 Variable Inlet Vane Control

Variable inlet vanes are mounted on the fan inlet to control air volume. Altering the pitch of the vane imparts a spin to air entering the fan impeller, which results in a family of fan performance curves as shown in Figure 18. Airflow reduction with inlet vanes is more efficient than with an outlet damper.

An **eddy current coupling** connects an AC-motor-driven fixed-speed input shaft to a variable-speed output shaft through a magnetic flux coupling. Reducing the level of flux density in the coupling increases slip between the coupling's input and output shafts and reduces speed. **Slip** is wasted energy in the form of heat that must be dissipated by fan cooling or by water cooling for large motors.

Figure 19 shows that reducing fan speed also generates a family of performance curves, but the required input power remains relatively high because the speed of the induction motor remains fairly constant.

2.1 VARIABLE-FREQUENCY DRIVES

An alternative to VAV flow control methods is the variable-frequency drive (VFD). (In this section, the term variable-frequency drive is considered synonymous with variable-speed drive [VSD], pulse-width modulated [PWM] drive, adjustable-speed drive [ASD], and adjustable-frequency drive [AFD].) An alternating-current variable-speed drive consists of a diode bridge AC-to-DC converter, and a pulse-width modulation (PWM) controller with fast-rise power transistors, usually insulated-gate bipolar transistors (IGBTs). These very fast-switching power transistors generate a variable-voltage, variable-frequency waveform that changes the speed of the AC motor. As shown in Figure 20, fan speed decrease saves substantial VFD input power because the required impeller shaft power varies as the cube of the speed.

Table 5 compares the values from Figures 17 to 20 in annual terms. Very high VAV energy performances can be achieved by

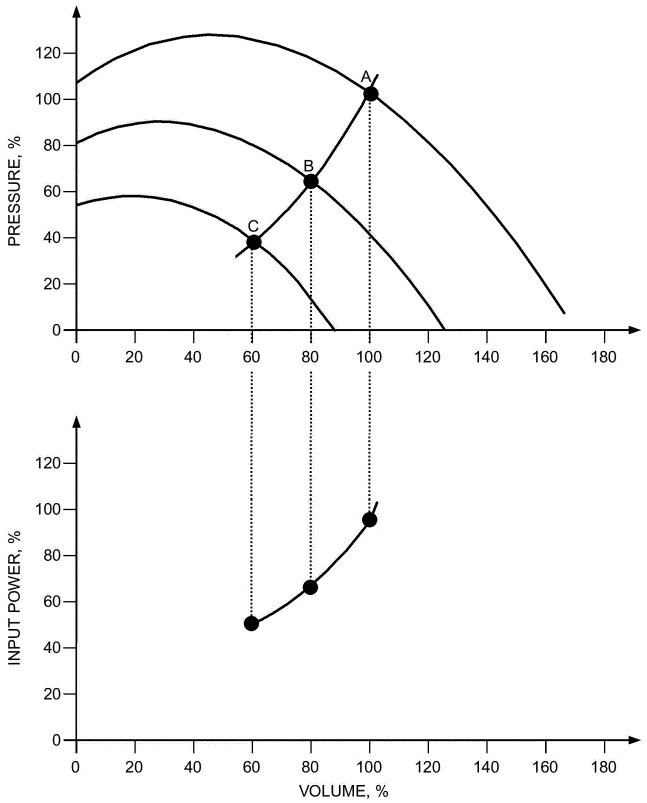


Fig. 19 Eddy Current Coupling Control

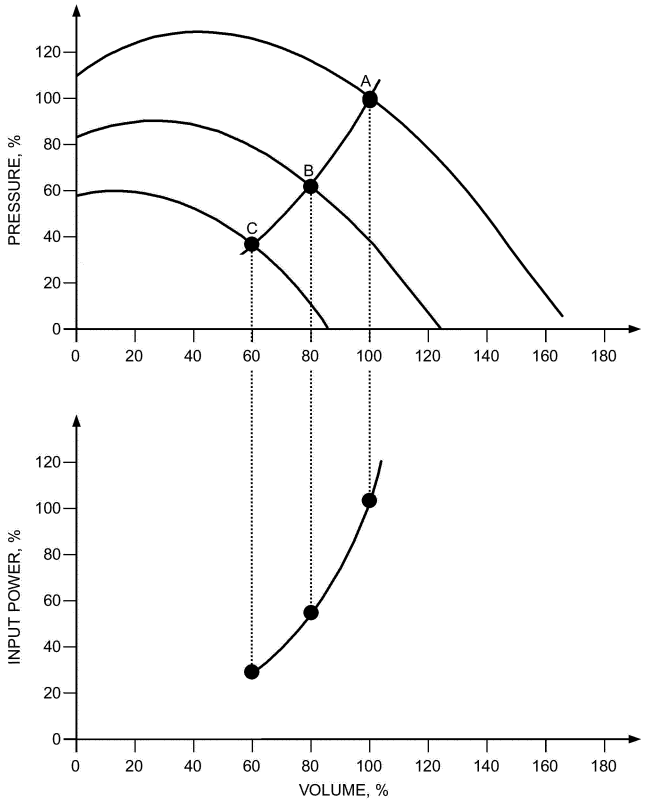


Fig. 20 AC Drive Control

Table 5 Comparison of VAV Energy Consumption with Various Volume Control Techniques

	Outlet Damper	Inlet Guide Vane	Eddy Current Coupling	AC PWM Drive
Input power,%	85	62	40	30
Annual kWh	335 000	244 000	158 000	118 000

NEMA Premium 75 kW motor producing 60% flow for 5000 h, driving fan system that requires 75 kW at unrestricted flow.

using a premium efficient motor with a VFD, which is typically over 96% efficient.

Power Transistor Characteristics

The key technology used to generate the output waveform is the IGBT. This transistor changes the characteristics of waveforms applied to a motor by varying (modulating) the width of pulses applied to the motor over each cycle of drive output voltage. Pulse-width modulation has been used for many years for variable-frequency drives; however, as transistor switching speeds increased, the pulse repetition rate (also known as the carrier or switching frequency) used also tended to increase, from 1 or 2 kHz to 8, 15, or as high as 20 kHz. This allowed motor drive manufacturers to provide a purer motor current waveform from the drive. Increased transistor switching speed and higher carrier frequencies introduced concerns over phenomena previously seen only in wave transmission devices such as antennae and broadcast signal equipment, and began to change the application variables such as drive-to-motor lead. These factors must be considered when applying newer IGBT-based VFDs.

Switching Times and *dV/dt*. Figure 21 shows the switching of a bipolar junction transistor (BJT) versus an IGBT as an example of how increased power device switching speeds can affect turn-on and turn-off times as a ratio of the overall cycle. Note that the BJT switches at 1.0 μs at a carrier frequency of 2 kHz, and the IGBT switches at 0.1 μs at a carrier frequency of 8 kHz. The IGBT switches at a speed 10 times faster than the BJT and generates 4 times the number of pulses over the same time period.

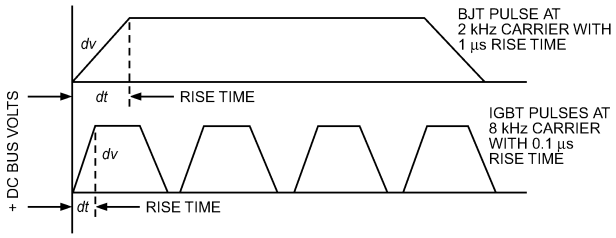


Fig. 21 Bipolar Versus IGBT PWM Switching

The rate of change of drive output voltage as the power device is switching is known as the *dV/dt* of the voltage pulse. The magnitude of the *dV/dt* is determined by measuring the time difference between 10 and 90% of the steady-state magnitude of the output pulses, and dividing this time difference into the 90%/10% steady-state pulse voltage magnitude. Note that the *dV/dt* and carrier frequency of the pulses are both a function of the drive design. Often, the carrier frequency is user settable. The maximum design carrier frequency sets the limits on how fast a transistor must cycle on and off.

Motor and Conductor Impedance

The waveform shown at the output of the drive may not be identical to the waveform presented at the motor terminals. Impedance in AC circuits affects the high-speed voltage pulses as they travel from the drive to the motor. When the cable impedance closely matches the motor impedance, the voltage pulses received at the motor closely approximate those generated by the inverter. However, when the motor surge impedance is much larger than the cable surge impedance, the drives' pulses may be reflected, causing standing waves and very high peak motor voltages. Figure 22 shows the surge impedance of both the motor and a specific type of cable for different-sized drives and motors. Note that a relatively small motor (less than 1.5 kW) has a very high impedance with respect to the typical cable and can be problematic. Larger motors (greater than 75 kW) closely match cable impedance values and are generally less of a concern.

Potential for Damaging Reflected Waves. Reflected waves damage motors because transmitted and reflected pulses can add together, causing very high voltages to occur at the motor terminals and within the motor-to-drive wiring. Because these voltage pulses are transmitted through the conductor over specific distances, cable length and type are both variables when examining the potential for damaging voltages. Figure 23 shows the typical relationship between cable type and distance, power device switching times, and ratio of peak motor voltage at motor terminals to peak voltage generated at the drive's output. Damaging reflected waves are most likely to occur in smaller motors because of the mismatch in surge impedance values. If multiple small motors are operated from a single VFD, the potential for reflected-wave insulation damage increases, because the cable length is the sum of all the motor cables connected to the VFD's output.

Figure 24 shows typical oscilloscope measurements taken at each end of a drive-to-motor conductor to describe the reflected wave phenomena. The time scale is set to display a single pulse. The two traces demonstrate the effect of transmitted and reflected pulses adding together to form damaging voltages. The induction motor must be designed to withstand these voltage levels.

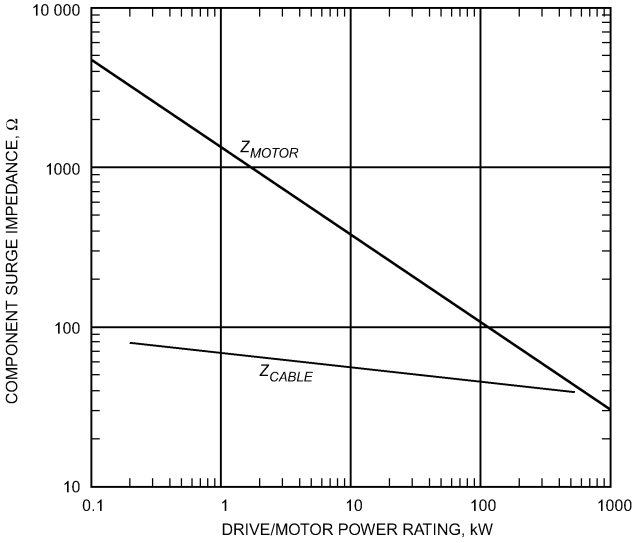


Fig. 22 Motor and Drive Relative Impedance

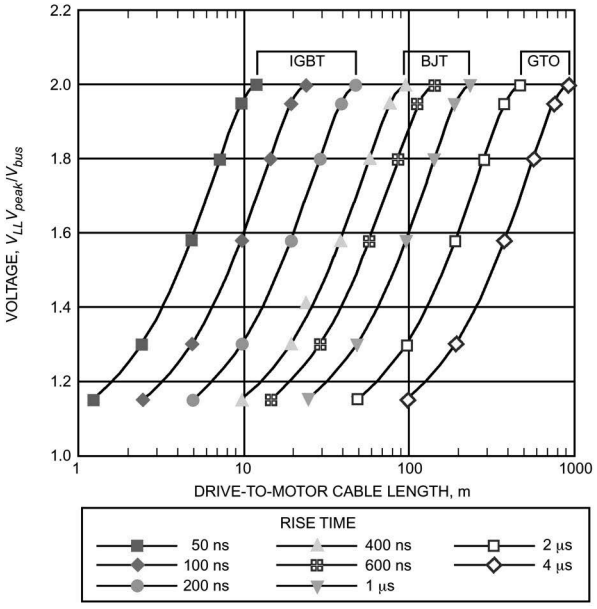


Fig. 23 Typical Switching Times, Cable Distance, and Pulse Peak Voltage

Motor Ratings and NEMA Standards

The term "inverter duty motor" is commonly used in the industry, although there is currently no commonly accepted technical definition of this term. The following sections are intended to assist engineers in specifying motors that are fed from VFDs. An induction motor is often constructed to withstand voltage levels higher than the nameplate suggests. The specific maximum voltage withstand value should be obtained from the manufacturer, but typical values for 208 and 460 V ac motors range from 1000 to 1800 V peak. Higher-voltage motors, such as 575 V ac motors, may be rated up to 2000 V peak. NEMA *Standard* MG 1, Revision 1, Part 30.2.2.8, gives established voltage limits for general-purpose motors, which are shown graphically in Figure 25. For motors rated less than 600 V, there is a peak of 1000 V and a minimum rise time

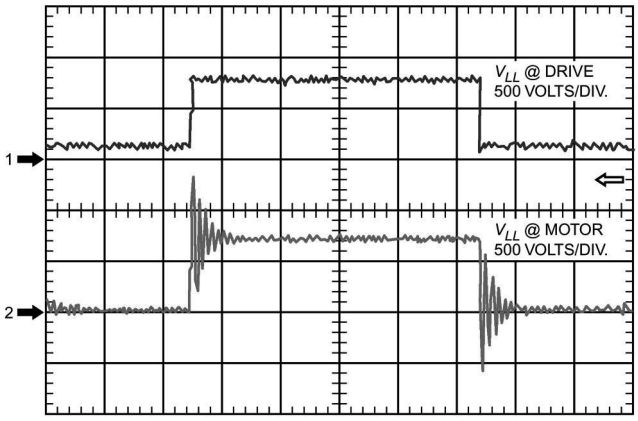


Fig. 24 Typical Reflected Wave Voltage Levels at Drive and Motor Insulation

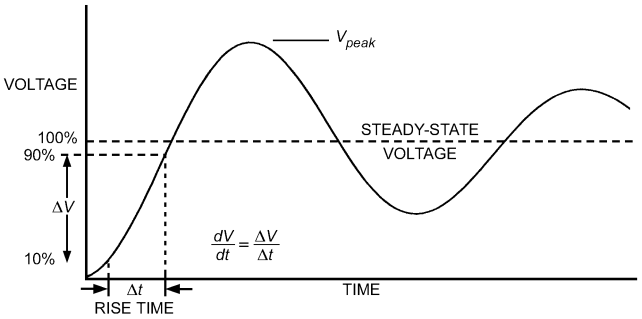


Fig. 25 Motor Voltage Peak and Limits

(Reprinted from NEMA *Standard* MG 1, Part 30, Figure 30-5 by permission of the National Electrical Manufacturers Association)

of 2 µs. Revision 1, Part 31, of this standard gives requirements for definite-purpose inverter-fed motors, which are required to have a somewhat higher voltage withstand value. Part 31.4.4.2 states that these motors must withstand a peak of 3.1 times rated voltage (e.g., 1426 V for a 460 V rating). The minimum rise time for these motors is 1 µs. When specifying motors for operation on variable-frequency PWM drives, the voltage withstand level (based on the drives and the known cable type and distance) should be specified.

Motor Insulation Breakdown. If reflected waves generate voltage levels higher than the allowable peak, insulation begins to break down. This phenomenon is known as **partial discharge (PD)** or **corona**. When two phases or two turns in the motor pass next to each other, high voltage peaks can ionize the intervening air and cause localized arcing, damaging the insulation. The voltage at which this effect begins is referred to as the **corona inception voltage (CIV)** rating of the motor (Figure 26).

Insulation subjected to PD eventually erodes, causing phase-to-phase or turn-to-turn short circuits. This causes microscopic insulation breakdown, which may not be detected by the drive current sensors and may result in nuisance overcurrent drive trips. Under this short-circuit condition, a motor may operate properly when run across the line or in bypass mode but consistently trip when run from drive power. Factory testing or special diagnostic equipment may be required to confirm this failure mode.

For short cable lengths and slower rise times, general-purpose motors may operate safely without reaching CIV. With longer cable lengths and higher rise times, even definite-purpose inverter-fed motors require mitigation. If details of the motor and cable run are

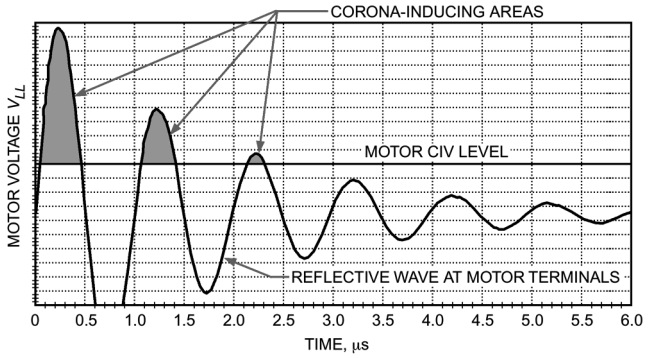


Fig. 26 Damaging Reflected Waves above Motor CIV Levels

specified, a VFD vendor should be able to prescribe any necessary mitigation filters to keep motor terminal peak voltage within a safe level.

Motor Noise and Drive Carrier Frequencies

Early PWM drives produced extreme motor noise at objectionable frequencies. IGBT technology allows drive designers to increase the carrier frequency to levels that minimize objectionable noise in the human hearing spectrum. Drive designs can switch up to 20 kHz, if required; however, some engineering compromises must be made to optimize the design. During the transition between turning off and on, the transistor generates heat that must be dissipated. This heat loss rises with the carrier frequency. Although higher carrier frequencies eliminate objectionable audible noise, they also require larger heat sinks and yield lower efficiency.

Audible noise measured in the dBA-weighted scale does not increase proportionally with drive carrier frequency. Additionally, concern with noise may not be over the measured total mean pressure level but a particular frequency band that is objectionable.

Figure 27 shows typical audible noise test results measured on a 75 kW energy-efficient motor. Note that the dominant octave band is at the drive carrier frequency setting. Sine wave power is used as a reference point on the left side of the graph. When running at 2 kHz, the total sound pressure is almost 6 dBA over the sine wave power recordings. This represents four times the sound pressure from the motor, because the scale is logarithmic and an increase of 3 dBA doubles the mean pressure level. By comparison, running the drive at 4 kHz increases the mean pressure by only 3 dBA, or half the mean pressure of the 2 kHz setting. (For reference, a 10 dB rise in sound pressure is perceived by the human ear as being twice as loud.)

Carrier Frequencies and Drive Ratings

In some manufacturers' drives, the carrier frequency is user-selectable. However, as carrier frequency increases, drive output ampere ratings often decrease, largely because of the additional heat that must be dissipated from the IGBT. If the rated carrier frequency of a drive is 2 kHz, setting the carrier frequency up to 8 kHz decreases the ampere output. Generally, for every 1 kHz increase in carrier frequency, the drive output current must be derated by 2%, although the specific derating should be determined by the drive manufacturer. As an example, a 7.5 kW, 460 V drive rated at 2 kHz may have an output of 14 A. If this drive is run at 10 kHz, or an increase of 8 kHz, it must be derated to 11.76 A, or a 16% decrease in current. If the motor nameplate full load were 14 A, this drive would not generate enough output current to obtain the full 7.5 kW. In effect, the drive and motor would only generate 6.3 kW continuously. This may not be enough power to drive a fan or pump at the

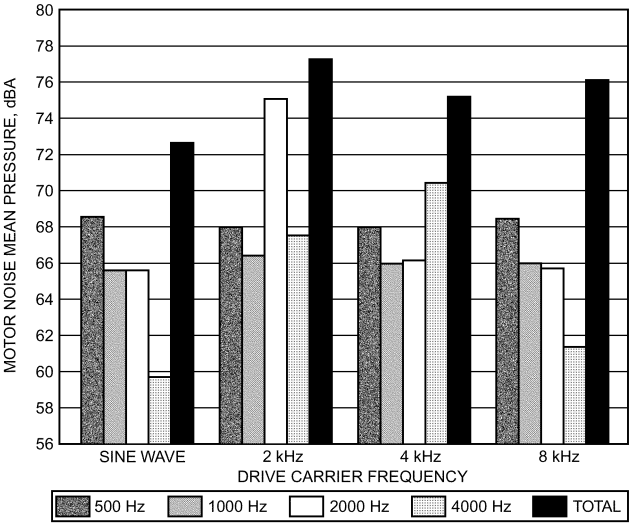


Fig. 27 Motor Audible Noise

performance specified for the application. For this reason, the specifying engineer should always state the desired audible sound level of the motor as applied to the drive to ensure proper operation.

2.2 POWER DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM EFFECTS

Variable-frequency drives draw harmonic current from the power line. It is important to distinguish these lower-order harmonics from high-frequency disturbances on the motor side of the drive caused by the PWM inverter. Line harmonics are particularly critical to AC drive users for the following reasons:

- Current harmonics cause additional heating in transformers, conductors, and switchgear. Current harmonics flowing through the impedance of the power system cause voltage harmonics in accord with Ohm's law.
- Voltage harmonics upset the smooth, predictable voltage waveform in a normal sine wave. A power system severely distorted by voltage harmonics may damage components connected to the line or cause erratic operation of some equipment.
- High-frequency components of voltage distortion can interfere with signals transmitted on the AC line for some control systems.

However, PWM AC drives with built-in bus reactors or external reactors ahead of the drive significantly mitigate any disturbance to the input power.

A **linear load**, such as a three-phase induction motor operated across the line, may cause a phase displacement between the voltage and current waveforms (phase lag or lead), but the shapes of these waveforms are nearly pure sine waves and contain very little harmonics.

In contrast, a **nonlinear load** may draw current only from the peaks of the AC voltage sine wave. This flattens the top of the voltage waveform in single-phase circuits, and depresses it on either side of the peaks in three-phase circuits. Nonlinear loads draw current from the power source that are rich in current harmonics. Many nonlinear loads connected to a power system can cumulatively inject harmonics. Single-phase equipment (e.g., TVs, VCRs, computers, electronic-ballast lighting) and three-phase equipment (e.g., VFDs, uninterruptible power supplies [UPSs], electric arc furnaces, electric heaters, welders) convert AC voltage to DC voltage and contain circuitry that draws current in a nonlinear fashion. Figure 28 shows how the current drawn by a PWM full-wave rectification VFD may distort the voltage waveform measured at the input terminals.

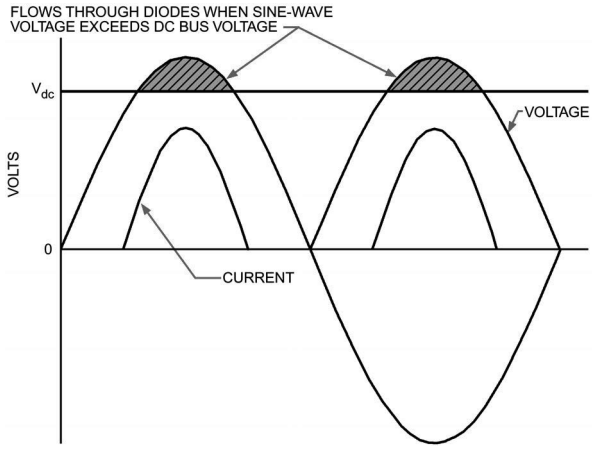


Fig. 28 Voltage Waveform Distortion by Pulse-Width-Modulated VSD

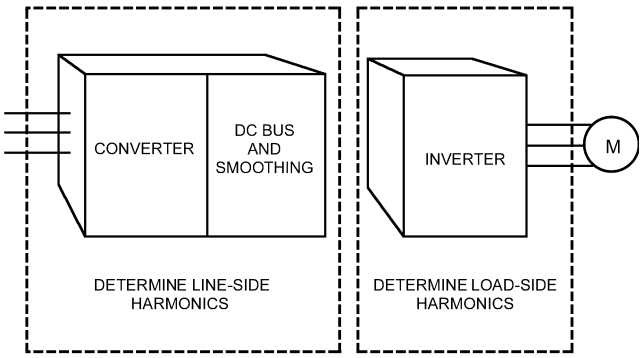


Fig. 29 Basic Elements of Solid-State Drive

A single-phase load is not necessarily too small to be of concern. With AC-to-DC converters, the demand current occurs around the peak of the voltage sine wave. A thousand 100 W fluorescent light fixtures consume 100 kW of power. If the lights are nonlinear loads, the peaks add directly and cause the voltage waveform to dip. This distortion in the single-phase voltage waveform contributes to the harmonic distortion of the three-phase power source. On single-phase harmonic distortion, these loads produce even-numbered harmonics such as 2nd, 4th, 6th, etc. Thus, if a balanced system is experiencing even-numbered harmonics, they must originate from a single-phase load and not from the drives. These loads may also use the neutral connection of the power source to conduct current; the neutral connection may overload if proper precautions are not taken to alleviate harmonic currents drawn by nonlinear loads.

VFDs and Harmonics

Figure 29 shows the basic elements of any solid-state drive. The converter section (for conversion of AC line power to DC) and the inverter section (for conversion of DC to variable frequency AC) both contain nonlinear devices that cause harmonics on the input and output lines, respectively. Input-line harmonics are caused solely by the converter section and are usually referred to as **line-side harmonics**.

The converter section and the inverter section are electrically isolated from each other when a sufficiently large DC bus capacitor bank is present and in some designs by a DC choke. In these cases, the output of the VFD affects only the driven motor, and line-side harmonics affect only the power distribution system. It is important to clearly define which harmonics are being analyzed, because imposing stringent current harmonic limits for the VFD output may not be required for most motors rated for PWM power.

Effects of Line-Side Harmonics. Generally, PWM AC drives that contain internal bus reactors or three-phase AC input line reactors help minimize electrical interference with other electrical equipment. But any harmonic current flowing through the source impedance causes a voltage drop that results in harmonic distortion of the supply voltage waveform. In general, the lower the drive's input current harmonics, the lower the risk of creating interference with other equipment through harmonic distortion. Ideally, the drive's input current waveform should be purely sinusoidal and contain no harmonic current distortion, similar to operation of a motor connected directly to the power source (current total harmonic distortion [THD] is ideally 0%). If VFDs are large or numerous, or if electrical system impedance is high, additional harmonic mitigation strategies may be necessary. A distorted supply voltage waveform can have the following undesirable effects on some equipment connected to the power line:

- Communications equipment, computers, and diagnostic equipment are "sensitive" (i.e., have low tolerances to harmonics). Typical effects include receipt of false commands and data corruption.
- Transformers may experience trouble caused by possible additional heating in the core and windings. Many transformer manufacturers rate special transformers by K-factor, which indicates the transformer's ability to withstand degradation from harmonics. Special cores to reduce eddy currents, specially designed windings that reduce heating, and an oversized neutral bus are some of the special design features found in some K-factor transformers. Other manufacturers simply derate their standard transformers to compensate for harmonic effects.
- Standby generators have voltage regulators that are susceptible to harmonics. In addition, generators have very high impedance compared to utility power. The harmonic currents flowing in this higher impedance can give rise to harmonic voltages three to four times normal levels. Compounding this problem is the fact that standby generators are usually installed where sensitive equipment is prevalent (e.g., hospitals, computer centers). Emergency power systems should be specified and tested to ensure they can serve the harmonic current load and still provide voltage clean enough for critical loads.

  Any VFD application with standby generators requires careful design, and the following information should be gathered:

  - Power output (kW, MW, or kVA) of the generator
  - Subtransient reactance
  - How the generator is applied in reference to the VFD; the worst-case running condition of the drives (number of drives running at one time, and load on these drives)

Additional problems can be caused by resonance that can occur when **power factor correction capacitors (PFCCs)** are installed. Resonance can severely distort the voltage waveform. PFCCs may fail prematurely, or capacitor fuses may blow. Additionally, because VFDs have an inherent high displacement power factor (typically 0.96 or greater), PFCCs should never be required or used with a drive. They can even cause the drive to fail if installed on the load side of the VFD. If an older motor is retrofitted with capacitors, PFCCs should be removed, because they are no longer required.

Only the fundamental current transmits power to the load. Harmonic currents increase the equipment input kVA without contributing to input power. Operating with a high harmonic content is much like operating at a low input power factor. High harmonic content means that higher total current is required to deliver a given amount of power because of equipment heat losses; thus, the true power

factor (kW/kVA) can be low even if the displacement power factor (cos θ) is high or unity. All components of the power distribution system must be oversized to handle the additional current. If the utility meters can measure the harmonic content and/or power factor, they may assess a distortion (demand) charge or power factor penalty.

Effect of Harmonics on a System. In most applications, no harmonic problems occur with six-pulse PWM VFDs that use a series reactor in the DC bus or in the input AC line. A 3 or 5% impedance AC reactor is often offered as an option on drives. Using a DC bus or AC reactor typically reduces the current THD level between 35 and 45%. If additional harmonic reduction is desired, passive harmonic filters or higher-order multipulse inputs of 12 and 18 pulse are sometimes offered, which reduce the input current THD to between 5 and 12%. Active harmonic filters are expensive but extremely effective, reducing harmonic distortion to levels of 3 to 5%.

A study can be performed of system harmonic performance to determine the expected contributions of nonlinear equipment. IEEE *Standard* 519 establishes guidelines for allowable harmonic current distortion by a customer's power system onto the power grid. These levels are directly related to the strength of the connected power grid. IEEE *Standard* 519 uses a ratio of the available short-circuit current from the utility to the peak demand current of the facility to set recommended **total demand distortion (TDD)** values. This guideline establishes the **point of common coupling (PCC)** as the "point on a public power system, electrically nearest to a particular load, at which other loads are, or could be, connected. The PCC is a point located upstream of the considered installation." The purpose of the study is to anticipate any potential harmonic issues, and any mitigation requirements.

With other nonlinear loads (e.g., arc furnaces, DC drives, current source drives) and other high-reactive-current loads, harmonic problems may exist. The following problems, typically more common on single-phase systems, may indicate a harmonic condition, but they may also indicate line voltage unbalance or overloaded conditions:

- Nuisance input fuse blowing or circuit breaker tripping
- Power factor capacitor overheating, or fuse failure
- Overheating of supply transformers
- Overheating neutral conductors and connectors (normally just on single-phase systems)

Problems that are *not* usually harmonic problems include

- Overcurrent tripping of VFDs
- Interference with AM radio reception
- Wire failure in conduits

2.3 PERFORMANCE TESTING AND RATING STANDARDS

ASHRAE *Standard* 222 is a laboratory method of test suitable for a broad range of power drive systems for HVAC&R applications with ≤600 V AC input voltage. It specifies wire-to-shaft testing of adjustable-speed electric AC power drive systems that combine semiconductor power converters including means for their control, protection, monitoring, and measurement with connected electric motors (Figures 30 and 31). All electric rotary motor types are included. Power converters may be either completely integrated in motor casing or may be remote for testing with reference motors. Testing includes input and output power for efficiency rating, harmonic current emissions, and peak voltage and voltage rise time at the terminals of a connected motor. Mandatory specifications in ASHRAE *Standard* 222 include power source quality, instrumentation, test setup and procedure, calculations, and reporting.

ANSI/AHRI *Standard* 1211 incorporates general test requirements and definitions from ASHRAE *Standard* 222. It establishes classifications, rating requirements, marking and nameplate data, conformance conditions, and minimum requirements for AHRI-certified published VFD ratings. These ratings provide users and specifying engineers a relative comparison between VFDs on the following three performance criteria:

- Efficiency of motor VFD combinations at four or seven duty points. (These loads and speeds emulate both variable-torque [VT] loads, such as fans and pumps, and constant-torque [CT] loads, such as compressors.
- VFD-generated harmonic current distortion at full load and speed, which is the operating point that generates worst-case effects on electrical power distribution systems.
- Peak voltage and rise time of that voltage seen at motor terminals with various cable lengths between the motor and VFD.

AHRI *Standard* 1211 includes the most common HVAC motor sizes. It does not address all VFD voltages and sizes, nor does it address use with all motor types. It is limited to the following: 1211

- 200 to 240 V with induction motors from 0.75 to 18.64 kW
- 380 to 480 V with induction motors from 0.75 to 44.74 kW
- 550 to 600 V with induction motors from 0.75 to 55.9 kW

Calculating VFD and Motor Efficiency

When determining efficiency, *Standard* 1211 takes a wire-to-shaft approach. Reported data are measured at the VFD input wire terminals to the motor shaft power. This method allows users to compare VFD power consumption values under the same test con-

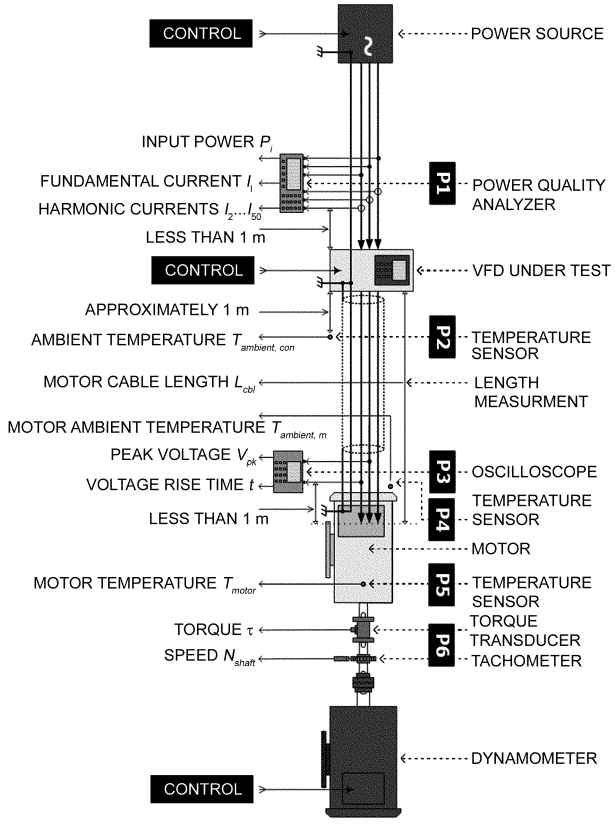


Fig. 30 Remote Complete Drive Module (CDM) Test Setup

(*Source*: ASHRAE *Standard* 222)

Table 6 Speed/Torque Points for Drive System Efficiency and Motor Stress Insulation Tests*

	Torque, %			
Speed, %	**16**	**25**	**56**	**100**
40	VT			CT
50		VT		CT
75			VT	CT
100				CT/VT

Source: Table 2, AHRI *Standard* 1211.
*Only cells that contain CT or VT are test points.

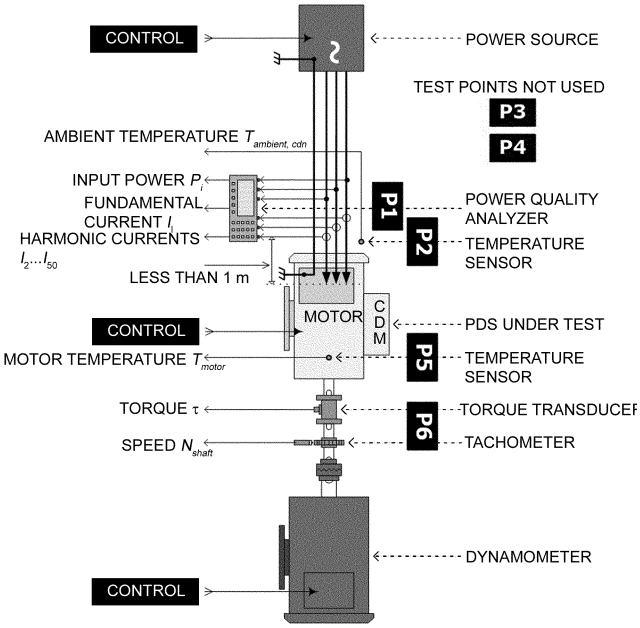


Fig. 31 Attached Complete Drive Module (CDM) Test Setup

(Test points P3 and P4 are not used.)
(*Source*: ASHRAE *Standard* 222)

ditions. By using a NEMA Design B EPACT-compliant motor (see NEMA *Standard* MG-1) for each VFD, the ratings of certified VFDs are comparable. The certified efficiency includes the driven motor and does not reflect the inefficiency of only the VFD. Small changes to the VFD settings, such as carrier switching frequency, can have a large effect on VFD efficiency *T*, so the certified data include the tested settings. To provide uniform test conditions, basics such as connected motor style and cable characteristics between the VFD and the motor are stated in AHRI *Standard*

Many fan and pump systems run at full speed only rarely. Stated efficiency as a single percentage value is therefore not representative of energy consumption. Instead, AHRI *Standard* 1211 establishes speed and VT points that follow the affinity laws for centrifugal machines. Manufacturers may also choose to certify VFDs for CT applications, wherein the torque is kept at 100% across all operating speeds. Table 6 lists the required test points from *Standard* 1211.

VFD-Generated Harmonics

The second criterion addressed in *Standard* 1211 is VFD-generated power line harmonics. The standard defines harmonics as the "total harmonic current distortion," represented as a percentage of the fundamental current as measured at the VFD input terminals. AHRI certification requires reporting individual harmonic currents up to the 50th frequency of the fundamental and the total harmonic current distortion (THD_i). All harmonics are published at 100% speed and torque, because this is the point at which harmonics contribute the most to overall power distribution system effects.

Motor Insulation Stress

The final test criteria in AHRI *Standard* 1211are VFD output characteristics and their possible effect on motor insulation systems. The certified published ratings of peak voltage and voltage rise time are measured at the motor terminals with cable lengths of 6, 15, and 30 mfor full speed and torque. Designers can expect longer motor life time when selecting VFDs with lower voltage peaks and longer rise times.

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CHAPTER 46

VALVES

Fundamentals 46.1
Manual Valves 46.3
Balancing Valves 46.4
Control Valves 46.5
Multiple-Purpose Valves 46.11
Safety Devices 46.12
Self-Contained Temperature Control Valves 46.12
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Steam Traps 46.15

1. FUNDAMENTALS

VALVES are the fluid-controlling elements in a piping system. They are constructed to withstand a specific range of temperature, pressure, velocity, and mechanical stress. The designer selects and specifies the proper valve based on system requirements and applications.

Valves have some of the following primary functions:

- Starting, stopping, and directing flow
- Regulating, controlling, or throttling flow
- Preventing backflow
- Relieving or regulating pressure

The following service conditions should be considered before specifying or selecting a valve:

1. Type of liquid, vapor, or gas
   - Is it a true fluid or does it contain solids?
   - Does it remain a liquid or is it two-phase throughout its flow?
   - Is it corrosive or erosive?
2. Pressure and temperature
   - Will these vary in the system?
   - Should worst case (maximum or minimum values) be considered in selecting correct valve materials?
3. Flow considerations
   - Is pressure drop critical?
   - Does the valve conform to the required pressure ratings?
   - Is the valve to be used for simple shutoff or for throttling flow?
   - Is the valve needed to prevent backflow?
   - Is the valve to be used for directing (mixing or diverting) flow?
4. Frequency and speed of operation
   - Will the valve be operated frequently?
   - Will the valve need to reposition itself quickly?
   - Should it move slowly?
   - Does the valve have a required default position if there is no power (e.g., fail to normal position or fail in place)?
   - Will valve normally be open with infrequent operation?
   - Will operation be manually adjusted or automatically controlled?

Nomenclature for basic valve components will vary for different manufacturers based on their desired applications, and should be selected based on system requirements.

Body Ratings

The rating of valves defines the pressure-temperature relationship within which the valve may be operated. The valve manufacturer is responsible for determining the valve rating. ASME *Standard* B16.34 should be consulted, and a valve pressure class should be identified. Inlet pressure ratings are generally expressed in terms of the ANSI/ASME class ratings or based on the body vessel pressure rating, depending on the style, size, and materials of construction, including seat materials. Tables in ANSI/ASME *Standard* B16.34 and in various books show pressure ratings at various operating temperatures.

Characterized ball valves do not use ANSI/ASME class ratings, but are given gage body pressure ratings (e.g., 4140 kPa [gage]). Many noncharacterized ball valves are rated as **water, oil, or gas (WOG)** body pressure rating based on the ambient temperature limit.

Materials

ASME *Standard* B16.34 addresses requirements for valves made from forgings, castings, plate, bar stock and shapes, and tubular products. This standard identifies acceptable materials from which valves can be constructed. The materials for valves should be selected based on application and compatibility with other piping materials. Some of the other considerations for material selection include

- Pressure-temperature ratings
- Close-off pressure
- Leakage rate
- Valve flow characteristic (flow versus stroke)
- Corrosion-resistance requirements
- Thermal shock
- Piping stress
- Fire hazard

Types of materials typically available include

- Carbon steel
- Ductile iron
- Cast iron
- Stainless steels
- Brass
- Bronze
- Polyvinyl chloride (PVC) plastic

Bodies. Body materials for small valves are usually brass, bronze, or forged steel and for larger valves, cast iron, cast ductile iron, or cast steel as required for the pressure and service. Listings of typical materials are given in Lyons (1982) and Ulanski (1991).

Seats. Valve seats can be machined integrally of the body material, press-fitted, or threaded (removable). Seats of different materials can be selected to suit difficult application requirements. The valve seat and the valve plug or disk are sometimes referred to as the valve trim and are usually constructed of the same material selected to meet the service requirements. The trim, however, is usually of a different material than the valve body.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.1, Hydronic and Steam Equipment and Systems.

Maximum permissible leakage ratings for control valve seats are defined in standards such as Fluid Controls Institute (FCI) *Standard* 70-2 or European (CEN) *Standard* EN 12266-1.

Stems. Valve stem material should be selected to meet service conditions. Stainless steel, bronze, and brass are commonly used stem materials.

Stem Packings and Gaskets. Valve stem packings are selected by the manufacturer based on their design life cycle for specific fluid temperatures and pressures. They undergo constant wear because of the movement of the valve stem, and both the packings and body gaskets are exposed to pressure and pressure variations of the control fluid.

Flow Factor and Pressure Drop

Flow through any device results in some loss of pressure. Some of the factors affecting pressure loss in valves include changes in the cross section and shape of the flow path, obstructions in the flow path, and changes in direction of the flow path. For most applications, the pressure drop varies as the square of the flow when operating in the turbulent flow range. For check valves, this relationship is true only if the flow holds the valve in the full-open position.

For convenience in selecting valves, particularly control valves, manufacturers express valve capacity as a function of a flow coefficient. The flow factor K_v is the volume flow (in cubic metres per hour) of water at a temperature between 5 and 40°C with a differential pressure drop across the valve of 100 kPa. Manufacturers may also publish valve coefficients at other pressure drops.

Figure 1 shows a typical test arrangement to determine the K_v rating with the test valve wide open. Globe valve HV-1 allows adjusting the supply gage reading (e.g., to 200 kPa); HV-2 is then adjusted [e.g., to 200 kPa (gage) return] to allow a test run at a pressure drop of 100 kPa (gage). A gravity storage tank may be used to minimize supply pressure fluctuations. The bypass valve allows fine adjustment of the supply pressure. A series of test runs is made with the weighing tank and a stopwatch to determine the flow rate. Further capacity test detail may be found in International Society for Measurement and Control (ISA) *Standard* S75.02.

Cavitation

Cavitation occurs when the pressure of a flowing fluid drops below the vapor pressure of that fluid (Figure 2). In this two-step process, the pressure first drops to the critical point, causing cavities of vapor to form. These are carried with the flow stream until they reach an area of higher pressure. The bubbles of vapor then suddenly collapse or implode. This reduction in pressure occurs when the velocity increases as the fluid passes through a valve. After the fluid passes through the valve, the velocity decreases and the pressure increases. In many cases, cavitation manifests itself as noise. However, if the vapor bubbles are in contact with a solid surface when they collapse, the liquid rushing into the voids causes high localized pressure that can erode the surface. Premature failure of the valve and adjacent piping may occur. The noise and vibration caused by cavitation have been described as similar to those of gravel flowing through the system.

Water Hammer

Water hammer is a series of pressure pulsations of varying magnitude above and below the normal pressure of water in the pipe. The amplitude and period of the pulsation depend on the velocity of the water as well as the size, length, and material of the pipe.

Shock loading from these pulsations occurs when any moving liquid is stopped in a short time. In general, it is important to avoid quickly closing valves in an HVAC system to minimize the occurrence of water hammer.

When flow stops, the pressure increase is independent of the working pressure of the system. For example, if water is flowing at 1.5 m/s and a valve is instantly closed, the pressure increase is the same whether the normal pressure is 500 kPa or 5000 kPa.

Water hammer is often accompanied by a sound resembling a pipe being struck by a hammer (hence the name). The intensity of the sound is no measure of the magnitude of the pressure.

Noise

Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* points out that limitations are imposed on pipe size to control the level of pipe and valve noise, erosion, and water hammer pressure. Some data are available for predicting hydrodynamic noise generated by control valves. ISA *Standard* S75.01 compiles prediction correlations in an effort to develop control valves for reduced noise levels.

Body Styles

Valve bodies are available in many configurations, depending on the desired service. Usual functions include stopping flow, allowing full flow, modulating flow between extremes, and directing flow. The operation of a valve can be automatic or manual.

The shape of bodies for automatic and manual valves is dictated by the intended application. For example, angle valves are commonly provided for radiator control. The principle of flow is the same for angle and straight-through valve configurations; the manufacturer provides a choice in some cases as a convenience to the installer.

The type or design of body connections is dictated primarily by the proposed conduit or piping material. Depending on material type, valves can be attached to piping in one of the following ways:

- Bolted to the pipe with companion flange.
- Screwed to the pipe, where the pipe itself has matching threads (male) and the body of the valve has threads machined into it (female).
- Welded, soldered, or sweated.
- Flared, compression, and/or various mechanical connections to the pipe where there are no threads on the pipe or the body.
- Valves of various plastic materials are fastened to the pipe if the valve body and the pipe are compatible plastics.

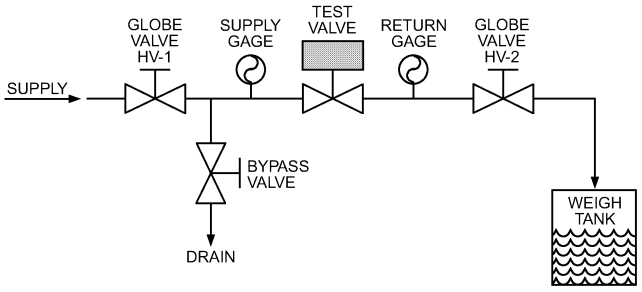

Fig. 1 Flow Coefficient Test Arrangement

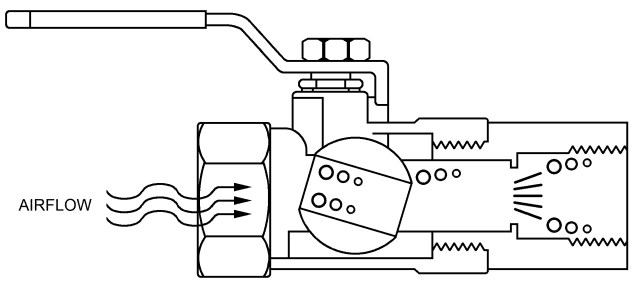

Fig. 2 Valve Cavitation at Sharp Curves

2. MANUAL VALVES

Selection

Each valve style has advantages and disadvantages for the application. The questions listed in the section on Fundamentals must be evaluated carefully.

Globe Valves

In a globe valve, flow is controlled by a circular disk forced against or withdrawn from an annular ring, or **seat**, that surrounds an opening through which flow occurs (Figure 3).

Globe valves are most frequently used in smaller diameter pipes but are available in sizes up to 300 mm. They are used for throttling duty where positive shutoff is required. Globe valves for controlling service should be selected by class, and whether they are of the straight-through or angle type, composition disk, union or gasketed bonnet, threaded, and solder or grooved ends. Three-way globe valves are also selected based on flow pattern (either mixing or diverting). Manually operated flow control valves are also available with fully guided V-port throttling plugs or needle point stems for precise adjustment. Globe valves have a relatively high pressure drop compared to ball valves when fully open and therefore should be used for throttling (flow control) rather than shutoff (stop flow) applications.

Gate Valves

A gate valve controls flow by means of a wedge disk fitting against machined seating faces (Figure 4). The straight-through opening of the valve is as large as the full bore of the pipe, and the gate movement is perpendicular to the flow path.

Gate valves are intended to be fully open or completely closed. They are designed to allow or stop flow, and should not be used to regulate or control flow. Various wedges for gate valves are available for specific applications. Valves in inaccessible locations may be provided with a chain wheel or with a hammer-blow operator.

Plug Valves

A plug valve is a manual fluid flow control device (Figure 5). It operates from fully open to completely shut off within a 90° turn. The capacity of the valve depends on the ratio of the area of the orifice to the area of the pipe in which the valve is installed.

The cutaway view of a plug valve shows a valve with an orifice that is considerably smaller than the full size of the pipe. Lubricated plug valves are usually furnished in gas applications. The effectiveness of this valve as a flow control device is reduced if the orifice of the valve is fully ported (i.e., the same area as the pipe size).

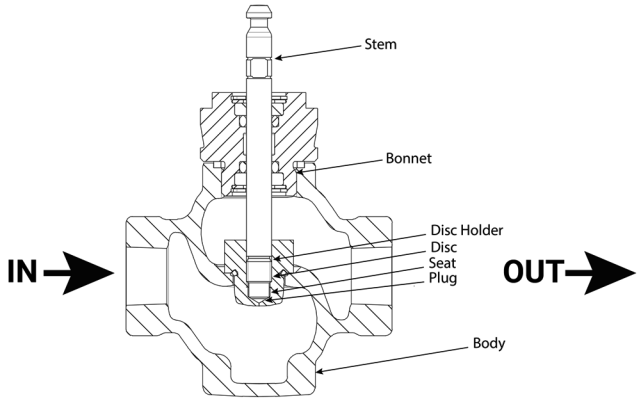

Fig. 3 Globe Valve

(Courtesy Belimo AirControls USA, Inc.)

Ball Valves

A ball valve contains a precision ball held between two circular seals or seats. Ball valves have various port sizes. A 90° turn of the handle changes operation from fully open to fully closed. Ball valves for shutoff service may be fully ported. Ball valves for throttling or controlling and/or balancing service should have a reduced port with a plated ball and valve handle memory stop. Ball valves may be of one-, two-, or three-piece body design (Figure 6).

Butterfly Valves

A butterfly valve typically consists of a cylindrical, flanged-end body with an internal, rotatable disk serving as the fluid flow-regulating device (Figure 7). Butterfly valve bodies may be **wafer style**, which is clamped between two companion flanges whose bolts carry the pipeline tensile stress and place the wafer body in compression, or **lugged style**, with tapped holes in the wafer body, which may serve as a future point of disconnection. The disk's axis of rotation is the valve stem; it is perpendicular to the flow path at the center of the valve body. Only a 90° turn of the valve disk is required to change from the full-open to the closed position. Butterfly valves may be manually operated with **hand quadrants** (levers) or gear

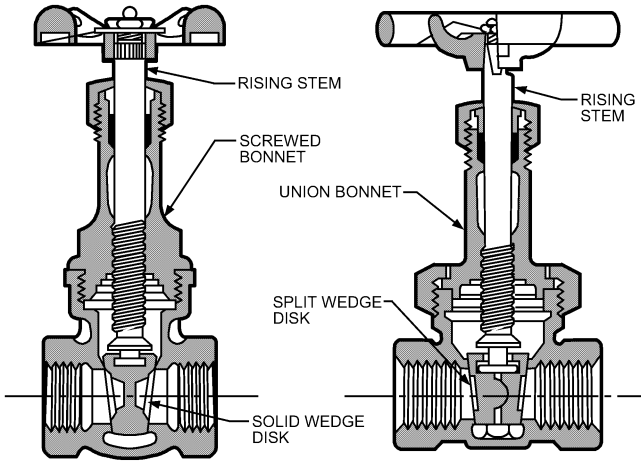

Fig. 4 Two Variations of Gate Valve

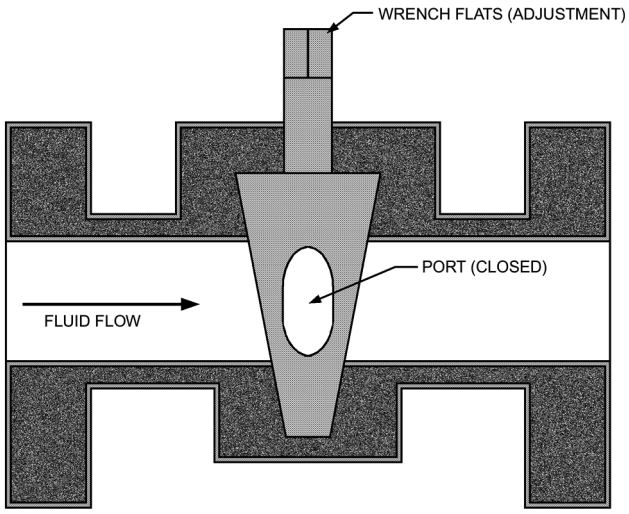

Fig. 5 Plug Valve

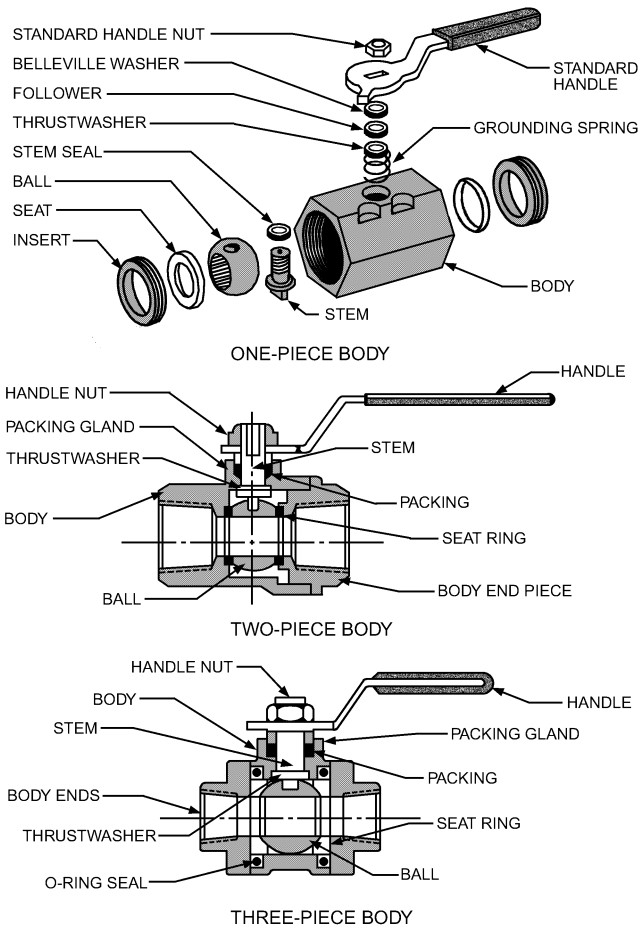

Fig. 6 Ball Valve

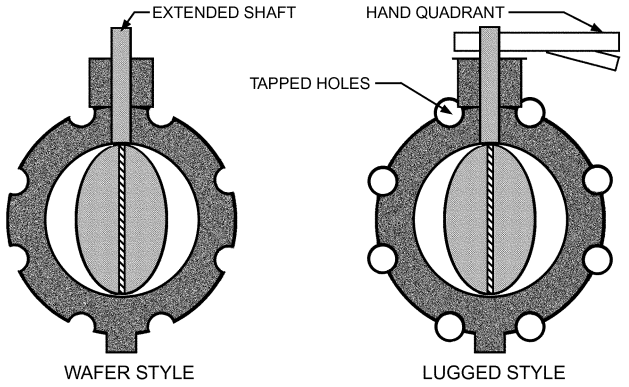

Fig. 7 Butterfly Valve

wheel operators, which are commonly used on larger valves. Valves may be provided with an extended shaft for automatic operation by an actuator. Special attention should be paid to manufacturers' recommendations for sizing an actuator to handle the torque requirements.

Butterfly valve characteristics include simple and compact design, a low corresponding pressure drop, and fast operation. Quick operation makes them suitable for automated control, and the low pressure drop is suitable for high flow. Butterfly valve sizing for on/off applications should be limited to pipe sizing velocities given in Chapter 22 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals*; on the other hand, for throttling control applications, the valve coefficient sizing presented in the section on Automatic Valves must be followed.

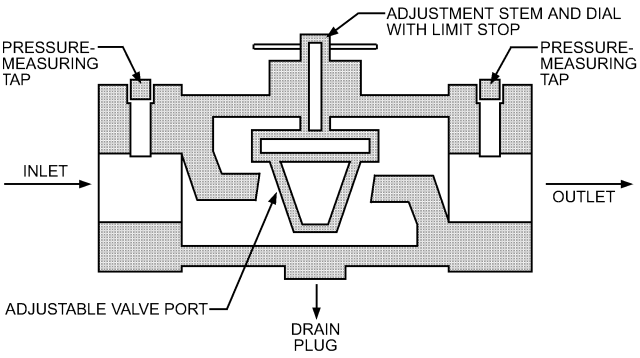

Fig. 8 Manual Balancing Valve

3. BALANCING VALVES

Balancing valves are placed in the distribution system to adjust water flow to a terminal, branch, zone, riser, or main. The valve should be located on the leaving side of the hydronic branch.

Two approaches are available for balancing hydronic systems: (1) a manual valve with integral pressure taps and a calibrated port, which allows field proportional balancing to the design flow conditions; (2) or an automatic flow-limiting valve selected to limit the circuit's maximum flow to the design flow.

Manual Balancing Valves

Manual balancing valves can be provided with the following features:

- Manually adjustable stems for valve port opening or a combination of a venturi or orifice and an adjustable valve
- Stem indicator and/or scale to indicate the relative amount of valve opening
- Pressure taps to provide a readout of the pressure difference across the valve port or the venturi/orifice
- Ability to be used as a shutoff for service of the heat transfer terminal
- Locking device for field setting the maximum opening of a valve
- Body tapped for attaching drain hose

Manual balancing valves may have rotary, rising, or nonrising stems for port adjustment (Figure 8). Manual balancing valves are pressure-dependent valves, which are designated with constant K_v values. The principle of manual balancing valves is that the flow will increase as the system pressure increases, and decrease as system pressure decreases.

Automatic Flow-Limiting Valves

A **differential pressure-actuated flow control valve**, also called an automatic flow-limiting valve (Figure 9), regulates the flow of fluid to a preset value when the differential pressure across it is varied. This regulation prevents an overflow condition in the circuit where it is installed, even when other system components are changing (modulating valves, pump staging, etc.).

Typically, the valve body contains a moving element containing an orifice, which adjusts itself based on pressure forces so that the flow passage area varies.

The area of an orifice can be changed by either (1) a piston or cup moving across a shear plate or (2) increased pressure drop to squeeze the rubber orifice in rubber grommet valves.

A typical performance curve for the valve is shown in Figure 10. The flow rate for the valve is set. The flow curve is divided into three ranges of differential pressure: the start-up range, the control range, and the above-control range.

Balancing Valve Selection

Manual balancing valves are selected using available C_v values based on required design flow, whereas automatic balancing valves are selected based on required design flow and minimum differential pressure. Manual balancing valves should be selected with 3 to 7 kPa pressure drop at the branch design flow when full open. Pressure drops that are too low or too high can affect the balancing valve's accuracy, so the selection of adequate K_v values based on required design flow is critical when selecting manual balancing valves. For automatic balancing valves, it delivers set design flow per selection. However, the operating pressure differential range of automatic balancing valves must be maintained to ensure desired set flow. See Chapter 39 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for balancing details.

4. CONTROL VALVES

Control valves operate in conjunction with an automatic controller or device to control the fluid flow. The control valve consists of a valve body and an actuator. The valve body and actuator may be designed so that the actuator is removable and/or replaceable, or the actuator may be an integral part of the valve body. This section covers the most common types of valve actuators and control valves with the following classifications:

- Two-way
  - Globe bodies
  - Ball valves
  - Butterfly valves
- Three-way (mixing and diverting)

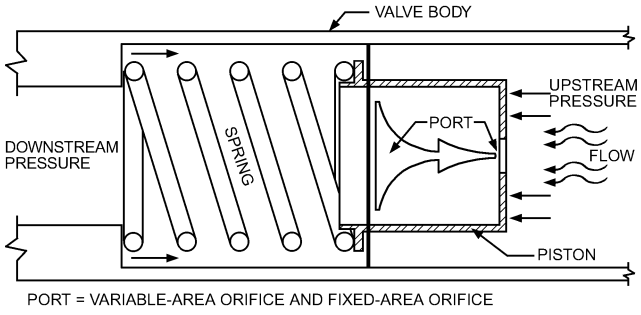

Fig. 9 Automatic Flow-Limiting Valve

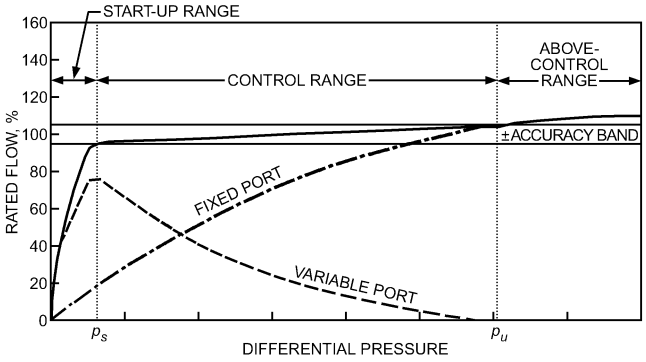

Fig. 10 Automatic Flow-Limiting Valve Curve

- Globe bodies
- Ball valves
- Butterfly valves

In a two-way valve, the fluid enters the inlet port and exits the outlet port either at full or reduced volume.

Three-way valves either mix or divert streams of fluid. Figure 11 shows some common applications for three-way valves. Figure 8 in Chapter 7 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* shows typical cross sections of three-way mixing and diverting globe valves. A **three-way mixing valve** blends two streams into one common stream based on the position of the valve plug in relation to the upper and lower seats of the valve. Output flow remains constant, and temperature is adjusted by mixing the two streams. A **three-way diverting** or **bypass valve** takes one stream of fluid and splits it into two streams for temperature control. Temperature at the coil is adjusted by varying output flow through the coil. In some limited applications, such as a cooling tower control, a diverting or bypass valve must be used in place of a mixing valve.

Globe Valves

Two-way globe valves may be single- or double-seated. In the single-seated globe valve, one seat and one plug-disk close against the stream. The style of the plug-disk varies depending on the requirements of the designer and the application. The double-seated valve is a special application of the two-way valve with two seats, plugs, and disks, and is generally applied where the close-off pressure is too high for the single-seated valve.

Ball Valves

Ball valves coupled with electronic direct-coupled actuators are common in HVAC control applications because it is easy to match the movement of the 90° actuator travel to the quarter-turn movement of the ball valve. For modulating flow applications, a reduced port or characterizing disc should be used on the ball valve to reduce the overall flow capacity K_v of the valve and modify the flow characteristic (e.g., equal percentage) to prevent overflow or uneven flow. The packing system of a characterized ball valve is designed to accommodate the modulating control action inherent in HVAC.

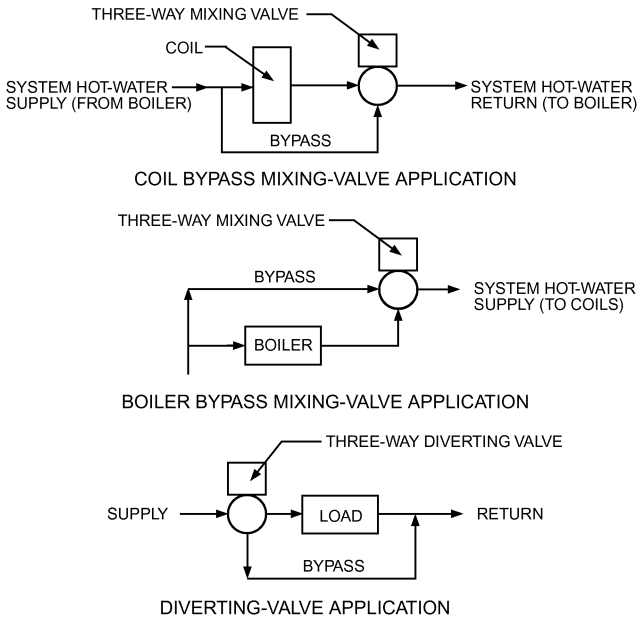

Fig. 11 Typical Three-Way Control Applications

Butterfly Valves

Butterfly valves are used in two-position and modulating applications. Advantages of butterfly valves are their ability to provide a bubble tight close off against higher pressures, their lighter weight, and compact size.

Butterfly valves are manufactured as two-way valves. In some applications where there is a need for a three-way valve application, two butterfly valves are connected to a piping tee and cross-linked to operate as either three-way mixing or three-way bypass valves (Figure 12).

Butterfly valves have different flow characteristics from standard seat and disk-type globe valves, so they may be used only where their flow characteristics suffice. When sizing a butterfly valve for a modulating application, use the K_v rating at 60° or 70° rotation; for two-position (on/off) applications, use the K_v rating at 90° rotation. It is also important to follow the manufacturer's guideline for the butterfly valve rating for maximum fluid velocity, because exceeding this figure can shorten the valve's life expectancy.

Flapper-Style Valves

Flapper styles valves have a paddle linked to a stem that open and closes based upon the type of actuation. The flapper style requires less torque for actuation, however the valves will typically have a lower close-off pressure rating compared to other styles.

Actuators

The valve actuator converts the controller's output, such as an electric or pneumatic signal, into the rotary or linear action required by the valve (stem), which changes the control variable (flow). Actuators cover a wide range of sizes, types, output capabilities, and control modes.

Sizes. Actuators range in torque output from small solenoid or wax thermal actuators, to large pneumatic and electronic actuators. Selection of the actuator takes into account the design requirement for the control signal, fail-safe operation, ambient conditions, and required close-off pressure rating of the valve assembly.

Types. The most common types of actuators used on automatic valve applications are solenoid, thermostatic radiator, pneumatic, electric gear train motor, electronic, and electrohydraulic.

Pneumatic Actuators

Pneumatic or diaphragm valve actuators consist of a flexible diaphragm clamped between an upper and a lower housing. On direct-acting actuators, the upper housing and diaphragm create a sealed chamber (Figure 13). A spring opposing the diaphragm force is positioned between the diaphragm and the lower housing. Increasing air pressure on the diaphragm pushes the valve stem down and overcomes the force of the load spring to close a direct-acting valve. Springs are designated by the air pressure change required to open or close the valve. For example, a pneumatic actuator on a direct-acting control valve with a 55 to 90 kPa spring range will have the control valve closed at pressures of 55 kPa and below. For pressures between 55 and 90 kPa, the valve will modulate proportionally based on the input control pressure. At 90 kPa and above, the control valve will be fully open. Springs for commercial control valves usually have ±10% tolerance. Two valves may be sequenced simply with different actuator spring ranges using a single control signal.

Reverse-acting valves may use a direct-acting actuator if they have reverse-acting valve bodies; otherwise, the actuator must be reverse-acting and constructed with a sealed chamber between the lower housing and the diaphragm.

The manufacturer's close-off rating tables need to be consulted to determine if the actuator is of an adequate size or if a larger actuator or a pneumatic positive positioner relay is required.

A **pneumatic positive positioner relay** may be added to the actuator to provide additional force to close or open an automatic control valve (Figure 13). Sometimes called **pilot positioners**, these are basically high-capacity relays that add air pressure to or exhaust air pressure from the actuator in relation to the stroke position of the actuator. Their application is limited by the supply air pressure available and by the actuator's spring.

Electric/Electronic Actuators

Electric (Gear Train) Actuators. Electric actuators usually consist of a double-wound electric motor coupled to a gear train and an output shaft connected to the valve stem with a cam or rack-and-pinion gear linkage (Figure 14). For valve actuation, the motor shaft typically drives through 160° of rotation. The use of damper actuators with 90° full stroke rotation is rapidly increasing in valve control applications. Gear trains are coupled internally to the electric actuators to provide a timed movement of valve stroke to increase operat-

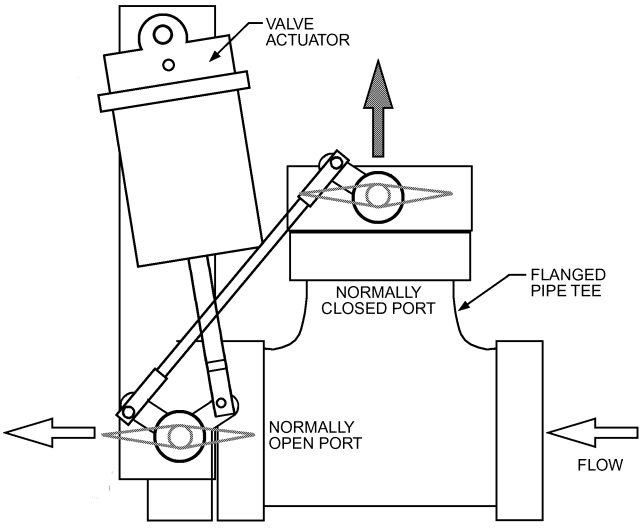

Fig. 12 Butterfly Valves, Diverting Tee Application

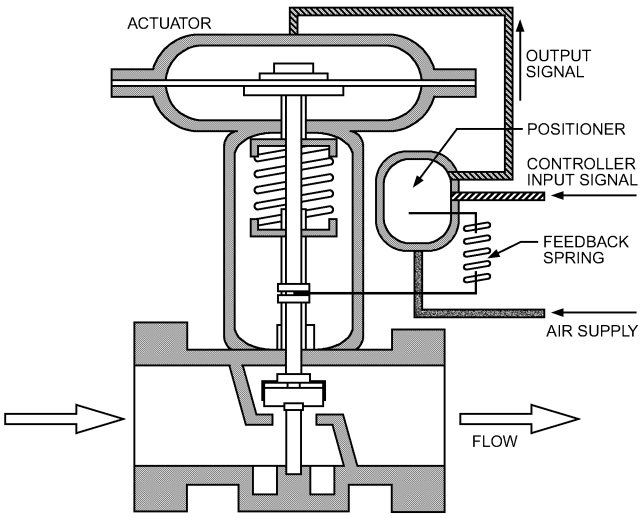

Fig. 13 Two-Way, Direct-Acting Control Valve with Pneumatic Actuator and Positioner

ing torque and to reduce overshooting of valve movement. Gear trains can be fitted with limit switches, auxiliary potentiometers, etc., to provide position indication and feedback for additional system control functions.

In many instances, a linkage is required to convert rotary motion to the linear motion required to operate a control valve. Electric valve actuators operate with two-position, floating, and proportional control. Actuators usually operate with a 24/120/240 V (AC) power supply. Actuator time to rotate (or drive full stroke) ranges from 60 to 150 s.

Electric valve actuators may have a spring return, which returns the valve to a normal position in case of power failure, or it may be powered with an electric relay and auxiliary power source.

Electronic (Direct-Coupled) Actuators. These actuators consist of a DC motor coupled to an internal gear box with an external clamp assembly. The actuator may be connected to a valve body by a linkage assembly, which converts the rotary motion of the actuator to the linear motion required by some valves. The actuator can also be directly coupled to the valve body (e.g., of a ball or butterfly valve), providing the quarter-turn opening required by the valve. Internal/external auxiliary switches and potentiometers can be added to provide position indication and feedback for additional control functions.

Electronic direct-coupled actuators operate with two-position, floating, and proportional control. Some can be programmed for unique control signals or to allow sequencing of two separate valves from a single control signal (similar to sequenced spring ranges in two pneumatic actuators). Actuators are available with 24/120/240 V or universal (AC) power supply. Typical rotation times (full closed to full open) are 90 to 150 s, but some models provide for programmable rotation times well outside of this range, from as fast as 5 s to as slow as 5 min.

Control valves can be selected as fail-safe or fail-in-place based on the stroke position they need to be in during power loss to the actuator. Fail-safe actuators use a mechanical spring or an electronic capacitor. The mechanical spring is internal to the actuator and provides enough torque to drive the valve to its fail position (either full open or full closed) as selected upon loss of power to the actuator.

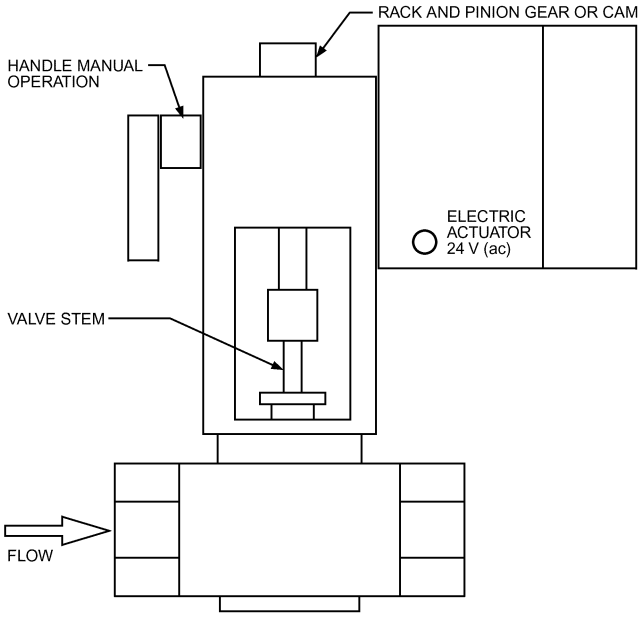

Fig. 14 Two-Way Control Valve with Electric Actuator

With an electronic fail-safe, on-board capacitors are charged when the actuator powers on. On a loss of power to the actuator, the voltage discharge of the capacitors allows the actuator to be powered sufficiently to drive the valve to a preselected fail position (full open, full closed, or some point in between). In both cases (mechanical or electrical fail-safe), the drive to fail position will only occur once. However, fail-in-place actuators will fail at their current position in case of loss of power to the actuator.

Electronic Hydraulic Actuators

Electronic hydraulic actuators combine characteristics of both electric and pneumatic actuators, with the internal hydraulic fluid replacing the air of the pneumatic actuator. A sealed housing contains the hydraulic fluid, pump, and some type of metering or control apparatus to provide pressure control across a piston or piston/diaphragm. A coil controlled by a low- to medium-level DC voltage activates the pressure control apparatus. The resulting output is a linear piston-type movement. This type of actuator is easily adapted to valves that require a linear motion, such as the stem movement of a globe valve. Electronic hydraulic actuators can be supplied with internal auxiliary switches for additional control functions. Actuators are available with 24/120/240 V (AC) power supply. Typical time to drive full stroke is 60 s. Electronic hydraulic actuators may be fail-safe, which returns the valve to its fail position upon a loss of power.

Solenoids

A solenoid valve is an electromechanical control element that opens or closes a valve on the energization of a solenoid coil. Solenoid valves are used to control the flow of hot or chilled water and steam and range in size from 3 to 50 mm pipe size. Solenoid actuators themselves are two-position control devices and are available for operation in a wide range of alternating current voltages (both 50 and 60 Hz) as well as direct current. Operation of a simple two-way, direct-acting solenoid valve in a deenergized state is illustrated in Figure 15.

Thermostatic Radiator Valves

Thermostatic radiator valves do not require an external energy source. They control space temperature by modulating the flow of hot water or steam through freestanding radiators, convectors, or baseboard heating units. Thermostatic radiator valves are available for a variety of installation requirements with remote-mounted sensors or integral-mounted sensor and remote or integral set point adjustment (Figure 16).

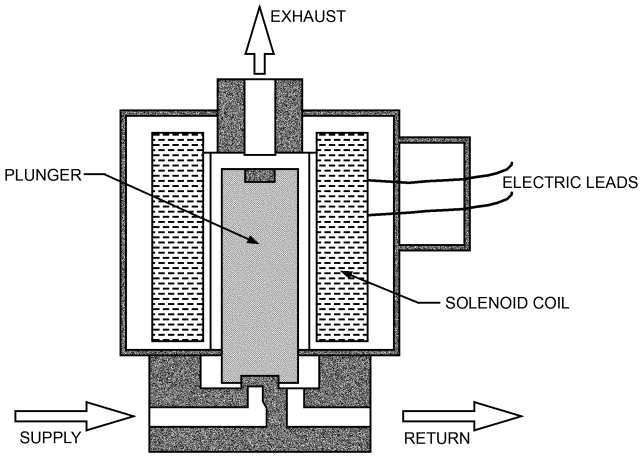

Fig. 15 Electric Solenoid Valve

Control of Automatic Valves

Computer-based (direct digital) control of automatic control valves has replaced older technologies and provides many benefits, including speed, accuracy, and data communication. However, care must be taken in selecting the value of control loop parameters such as loop speed and dead band (allowable set-point deviation). High loop speed coupled with very low dead band can cause the valve actuator to seek a new control position with each control loop cycle. For example, a 1 s control loop with zero dead band could result in more than 30 000 000 repositions (corrections) in 1 year of service. This **dithering** effect will shorten the life of the actuator.

However, computer-based control systems will not necessarily shorten the life of all automatic control valves. Computer-based control systems with properly tuned proportional integral and derivative (PID) loops provide the minimum acceptable level of response and accuracy required for the application to achieve maximum valve and actuator service life.

Special-Purpose Valves

Special-purpose valve bodies may be used on occasion. One type of four-way valve is used to allow separate circulation in the boiler loop and a heated zone. Another type of four-way valve body is used as a changeover refrigeration valve in heat pump systems to reverse the evaporator to a condenser function. Six-way valves are commonly used with four-pipe chilled-beam systems having two coil connections (supply and return), which limits output to the chilled beam to either heating, cooling, or neither.

Float valves are used to supply water to a tank or reservoir or serve as a boiler feed valve to maintain an operating water level at the float level location (Figure 17).

Pressure-Independent Control Valves

Pressure-independent control valves (PICVs; Figure 18) are control valves coupled with an internal method of differential pressure regulation to eliminate variances of flow caused by differential pressure fluctuations across the valve assembly. This can be accomplished by using a dynamic pressure regulator or integrated software to monitor the flow in relation to the designed output of the valve similar to a pressure-independent variable-air-volume (VAV) box. In practical application, a PICV replaces both a control valve and a balancing device.

The flow of standard pressure-dependent control valves (globe valves, ball valves, etc.) depends on the pressure differential across the valve. As pressure rises across a standard valve with a fixed stem position, the flow increases. Likewise, as differential pressure across the valve drops, the flow decreases. Therefore, the pressure-dependent control valves (globe, ball, etc.) are often referred to as constant-flow-coefficient (K_v) components, as well. This change in pressure across the control valve is caused by factors such as the modulation of other control valves in the hydronic loop. Additionally, varying differential pressure across a control valve results in over- and underflow caused by rapid changes in flow with small changes in valve positioning (see the section on Control Valve Flow Characteristics).

Advantages of PICVs include stable flow when the stem position is fixed, regardless of pressure fluctuations, and the elimination of a hydronic balancing device (e.g. balancing valve, flow-limiting device) where the PICV is mounted. Sizing a PICV is straightforward because it is no longer necessary to calculate a K_v for the valve.

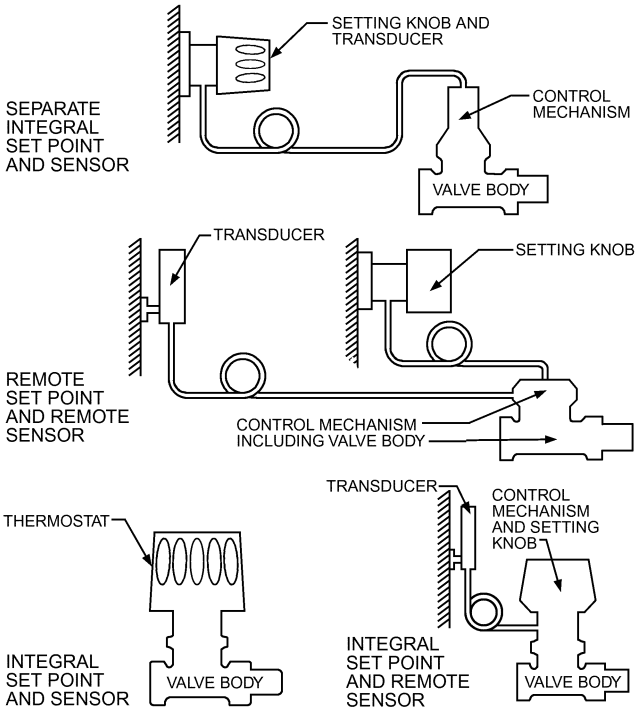

Fig. 16 Thermostatic Valves

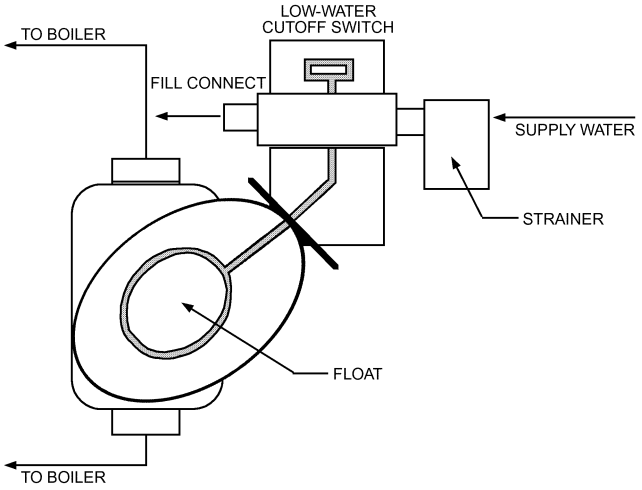

Fig. 17 Float Valve and Cutoff Steam Boiler Application

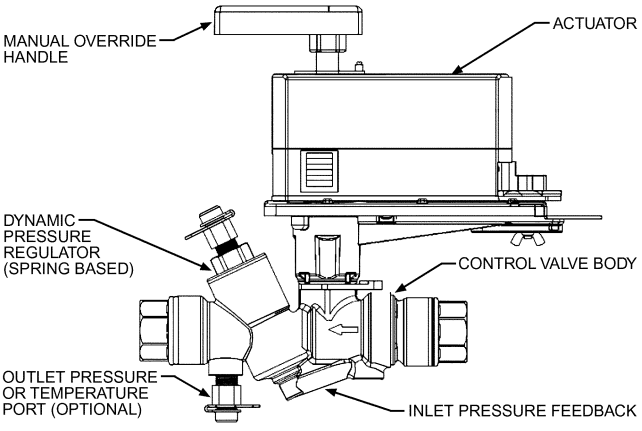

Fig. 18 Pressure-Independent Control Valve

PICV selection is always based on the full-open valve flow required. Ultimately, PICVs operate as if they have a perfect valve authority, even though having a perfect valve authority is mathematically impossible.

PICVs are rated for a differential pressure range (e.g., 35 to 350 kPa) where the PICV is pressure independent. If the pressure falls outside this range, the PICV will become a pressure-dependent valve, susceptible to flow variations from pressure changes. This differential pressure range is an operating range unrelated to the close-off pressure of the valve itself.

PICVs can be field adjustable for their maximum flow set point by either adjusting actuator end stops or programming, thereby eliminating the need to remove and replace components. The only limitation to adjusting the flow is the capacity of the valve body itself.

Flow-Limiting Valves

Flow-limiting valves (FLVs) are balancing valves coupled with an integrated flow-limiting device that prevents the flow from exceeding a predetermined limit. Flow is limited by an internal cartridge assembly. The FLV will not allow the flow to exceed the flow limit when operating within the predefined differential pressure operating range (e.g., 5 to 100 kPa, 10 to 220 kPa). However, unlike a pressure-independent control valve that eliminates flow variations (i.e., the over- and underflow caused by pressure across the entire opening range of the control valve), FLVs essentially do nothing when flow is below design when the valve is throttling flow, and do nothing to limit differential pressure across the control valve (Peterson 2017).

The flow limit of FLVs can be field adjusted by (1) replacing their internal cartridge or (2) external adjustment, with the only limitation being the flow capacity of the valve body.

Control Valve Flow Characteristics

Based on the characteristics of the valve, three distinct flow conditions are possible (Figure 19):

- **Quick Opening.** When started from the closed position, a quick-opening valve allows a considerable amount of flow through a small opening of the valve. As the valve moves toward the full open position, the rate at which the flow is increased is reduced in a nonlinear fashion. This characteristic is used in two-position or on/off applications, because it is very difficult to position the stem accurately enough for low and medium flows in modulating applications.
- **Linear.** Linear valves produce equal flow increments per equal increments of the valve moving towards the full open position. This characteristic is commonly used on steam coil terminals, bypass applications, and sometimes in the bypass port of three-way valves.
- **Equal Percentage.** This type of valve produces an exponential flow increase as the valve moves from the closed to the open position. For equal increments of the valve opening, the flow increases by an equal percentage. For example, in Figure 16, if the valve modulates from 50 to 70% of full stroke, the percentage of full flow changes from 10 to 25%, an increase of 150%. Then, if the valve modulates from 80 to 100% of full stroke, the percentage of full flow changes from 40 to 100%, again, an increase of 150%. This characteristic is recommended for control of hot- and chilled-water coils to linearize the output of the coil-valve combination, which makes control tuning easier and typically results in more stable systems.

The designer combines the valve flow characteristic with the coil performance curve (heating or cooling) to ensure the proper heat transfer characteristic. (Figure 20). The coil output (Figure 20A) of a heating or cooling coil increases rapidly and begins to slow as it nears the design point. Mating this coil output with its mirror image in flow percentage (i.e., the equal percentage flow characteristic) as shown in Figure 20B results in a linear coil output (Figure 20C).

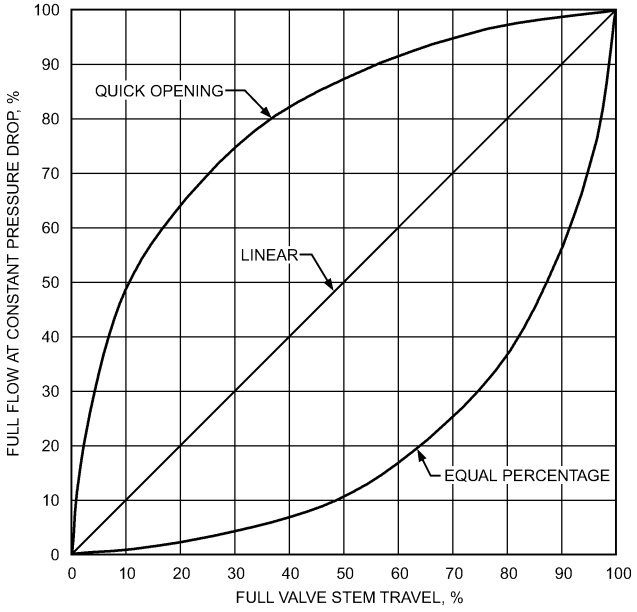

Fig. 19 Control Valve Flow Characteristics

The three flow patterns are obtained by imposing a constant pressure drop across the modulating valve, but in actual conditions, the pressure drop across the valve varies between a maximum (when it is controlling) and a minimum (when the valve is near full open). Figures 21 and 22 show how linear and equal-percentage valve flow characteristic are distorted as the control valve authority is reduced because of a reduction in valve pressure drop. The quick-opening characteristic (not shown) is distorted to the point that it approaches two-position or on/off control. The selection of the control valve pressure drop directly affects the valve authority and should be at least 25 to 50% of the branch pressure drop (i.e., the pressure drop from the branch connection from the supply main to return main, including the piping, fittings, coil, balancing device, and control valve). The location of the control valve in the system results in unique pressure drop selections for each control valve. A higher valve pressure drop allows a smaller valve size and better control, but also higher friction energy losses.

Authority ranges between 0.0 and 1.0. A low authority can cause the coil output to be quick opening instead of providing the desired linear coil output, causing the flow, temperature, and pressure oscillations discussed previously. Low valve authority leads to unstable flow through the control valve during low-load conditions. An authority of 1.0 will cause the valve to operate along its theoretical curve. A high authority value results in high pressure losses, even when the valve is full open. In modulating applications, an authority between 0.25 and 0.5 usually provides the right balance between controllability and energy performance.

$$\text{Authority} = \frac{\text{Differential pressure of valve}}{\text{(Differential pressure of valve + Differential pressure of branch)}}$$

Control Valve Sizing

Liquids. Two-position valves are generally selected to be the same size as the pipe; however, the K_v should be verified to ensure proper flow capacity: a wide range of flow capacities is available, especially in the smaller valve sizes. The flow characteristic (e.g., linear, equal percentage) does not matter in this application, so any

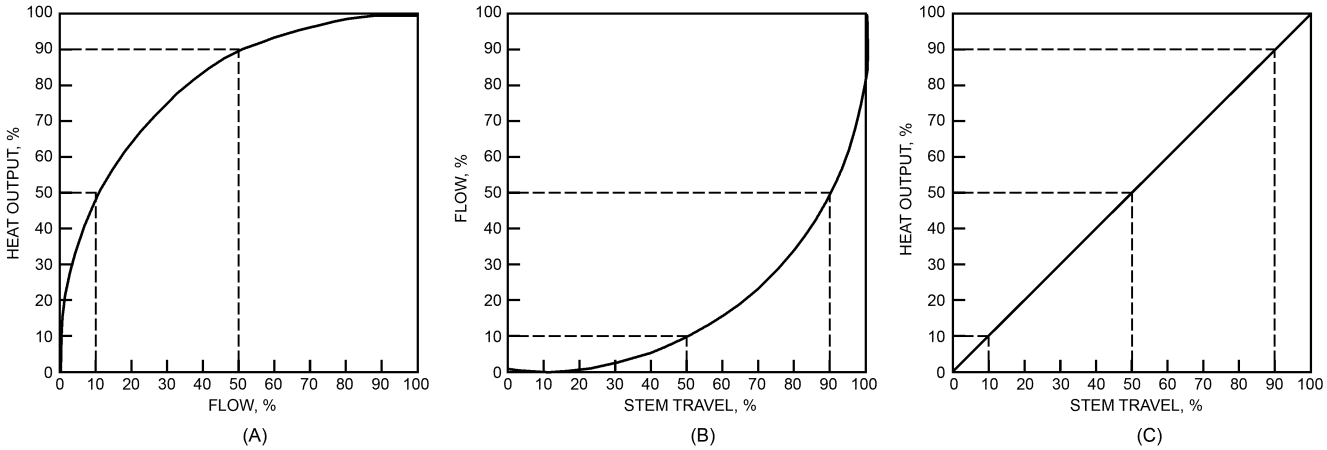

Fig. 20 Heat Output, Flow, and Stem Travel Characteristics of Equal-Percentage Valve

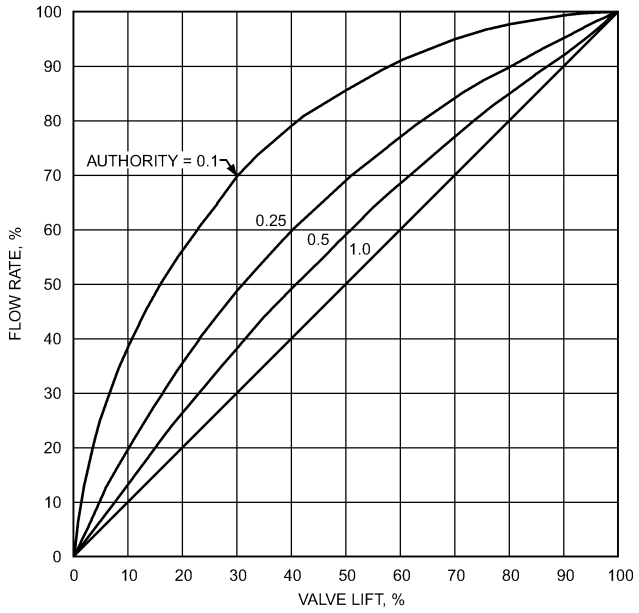

Fig. 21 Authority Distortion of Linear Flow Characteristics

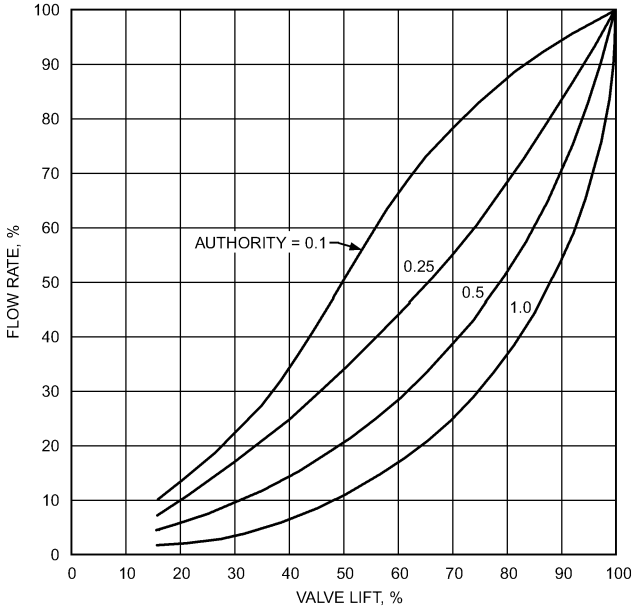

Fig. 22 Authority Distortion of Equal-Percentage Flow Characteristic

type can be used. Ball valves should be selected without a characterizing disc and for the largest port size (largest K_v).

Sizing modulating pressure-dependent valves is based on the following equation for flow factor K_v:

$$K_v = Q(\text{SG}/0.01\Delta p)^{0.5} \quad (1)$$

where

K_v = flow factor
Q = flow, m^3/h
SG = specific gravity of fluid = 1 (for water), dimensionless
Δp = pressure drop, kg/cm^2

Note that C_v (used with I-P units) and the SI equivalent K_v are not numerically equal. Therefore, before selecting valves from a catalog expressed in the other unit system, convert the calculated value as follows: $C_v = 1.16K_v$; $K_v = 0.862C_v$.

To determine the flow factor K_v of a control valve, the flow rate and the pressure drop desired across the control valve must be known.

The flow rate should be obtained from the design, shop drawings, the equipment itself, or other available data. The desired pressure drop is required to provide reasonable authority as discussed in the previous section.

Pressure drop and, ultimately, the valve sizing itself are based on the valve in a fully open state, because the valve capacity must be large enough to handle the design flow conditions. To estimate the desired pressure drop, first determine whether the valve is a two-position (on/off) or modulating (floating/proportional) type of control.

Two-position (on/off control) valves are sized with a 6.9 kPa pressure drop. Thus, if flow is 2.27 m^3/h, the desired K_v for the two-position control valve is

$$K_v = Q(\text{SG}/0.01\Delta p)^{0.5} = Q(1/0.01\Delta p)^{0.5} = Q/(0.01\Delta p)^{0.5}$$
$$= 2.27/(0.069)^{0.5} = 2.27/0.263 = 8.63 \quad (2)$$

$$K_v = Q(\text{SG}/0.01\Delta p)^{0.5} = Q(1/0.01\Delta p)^{0.5} = Q/(0.01\Delta p)^{0.5}$$
$$= 2.27/(0.069)^{0.5} = 2.27/0.263 = 8.63) \quad (2)$$

The selected control valve should have a K_v as close as possible to that calculated using this equation, without going below this value.

Caution: in a two-position application, the "rule of thumb" historically has been to select a line-sized control valve. However, with many more selections of K_v values now available across the range of control valves, specifying a 13 mm control valve for a 13 mm line without specifying the K_v could result in the installation of a valve with a K_v below 1.

Often, designers will specify a pressure drop higher than 6.9 kPa for a two-position control valve. For example, with a maximum flow required of 2.27 m^3/h, but using a 27.6 kPa pressure drop across the control valve instead of 6.9 kPa,

$$K_v = 2.27/(0.276)^{0.5} = 2.27/0.525 = 4.3 \quad (3)$$

This result indicates that the valve will have only half the capacity at 27.6 kPa pressure differential as it would at the 6.9 kPa differential used in the previous calculation.

Modulating valves are sized using the same flow coefficient equation. However, because the control valve is modulating the pressure across the valve, the pressure differential will be higher than that of a two-position control valve. As stated previously, the pressure drop across the control valve should be 25 to 50% of the branch pressure. Many factors affect the branch pressure, and it varies as other valves in the system open and close. To avoid the complexity of hydraulic circuit analysis, a rule of thumb for desired control valve pressure drop is 28 to 35 kPa.

For example, the K_v for a modulating control valve in a reheat coil application with a flow rate of 0.68 m^3/h and 34.5 kPa, pressure drop is

$$K_v = 0.68/(0.345)^{0.5} = 0.68/0.587 = 1.16 \quad (4)$$

Note that installed flow coefficients may vary from catalog values because of pipe geometry factors, particularly with low-pressure drop valves such as full-port ball valves and butterfly valves. The greater the difference in valve and piping line size, the larger the impact on installed (corrected) flow coefficient. Where multiple flow coefficients are available for a given valve line size, such as with ball valves, the valve should be selected to match the pipe line size where available. Where the valve must be smaller than the line size, consult the manufacturer for flow coefficient adjustments. Typically, if the valve is no more than one size smaller than the pipe line size, the impact will be negligible for globe and characterized ball valves.

Steam. For steam flow, the inlet and outlet pressures of the steam, and the type of control (modulating or two-position) must be taken into account:

$$Q = 0.021 C_v / K[\Delta p(P_1 + P_2)]^{0.5} \quad (5)$$

where

Q = steam mass flow, kg/h
K = 1 + (0.0015 × °C superheat). Typically, this value is 1 for nonsuperheated steam.
C_v = flow coefficient
P_1 = differential pressure (inlet pressure – outlet pressure), kPa
P_2 = outlet steam pressure (absolute), kPa

There are two cases for selecting the differential pressure across the steam control valve:

1. Inlet steam pressure ≤ 103.4 kPa (gage).
   a. Two-position (on/off) control: differential pressure = 10% of inlet steam gage pressure.
   b. Proportional control: differential pressure = 80% of inlet steam gage pressure
2. Inlet steam pressure > 103.4 kPa (gage).
   a. Two-position (on/off) control: differential pressure = 10% of inlet steam absolute pressure.
   b. Proportional control: differential pressure = 25% of inlet steam absolute pressure.

Whenever possible, avoid selecting the differential pressure higher than 42% (saturated steam), because this takes the steam in the valve into critical or sonic velocity operation. In this case, the flow and K_v do not follow Equation (5), instead conforming to the following equation:

$$w_s = 0.016 K_v P_1 \quad (6)$$

where

w_s = steam flow, kg/h
K_v = flow factor
P_1 = entering steam absolute pressure, kPa

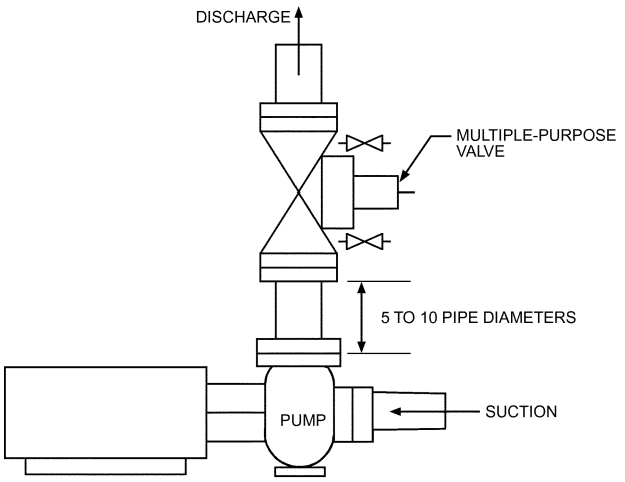

Fig. 23 Typical Multiple-Purpose Valve (Straight Pattern) on Discharge of Pump

5. MULTIPLE-PURPOSE VALVES

Multiple-purpose valves are made in straight pattern or angle pattern. The valves can provide shutoff for servicing or can be partially closed for balancing. Pressure gage connections to read the pressure drop across the valve can be used with the manufacturer's calibration chart or meter to estimate the flow. Means are provided to return the valve to its as-balanced position after shutoff for servicing. The valve also acts as a check valve to prevent backflow when parallel pumps are used and one of the pumps is cycled off.

Figure 23 shows a straight pattern multiple-purpose valve designed to be installed 5 to 10 pipe diameters from the pump discharge of a hydronic system.

Figure 24 shows an angle pattern multiple-purpose valve installed 5 to 10 pipe diameters downstream of the pump discharge with a common gage and a push button trumpet valve manifold to measure the differential pressure across the strainer, pump, or multiple-purpose valve. From this, the flow can be estimated. The differential pressure across the pump suction strainer can also be estimated to determine whether the strainer needs servicing.

Six-Way Control Valves

Figure 25 shows six-way control valves, which combine heating- and cooling-actuated control valves into one body. Typically, one side (left or right) of the body is connected to the supply and return

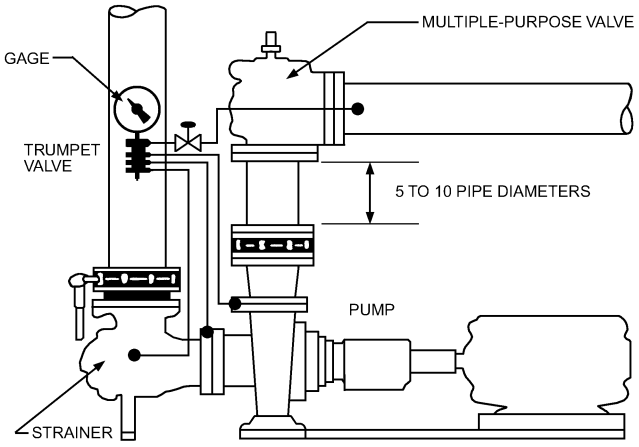

Fig. 24 Typical Multiple-Purpose Valve (Angle Pattern) on Discharge of Pump

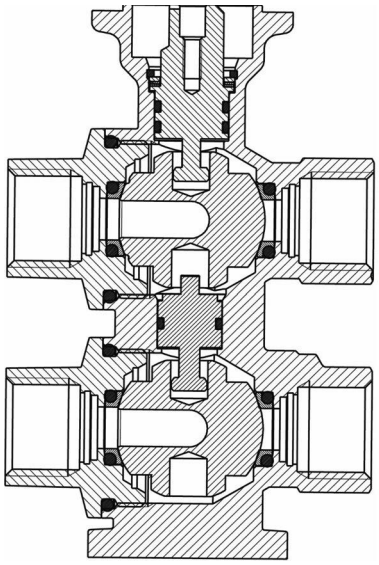

Fig. 25 Six-Way Control Valve

(Courtesy Belimo AirControls USA, Inc.)

of chilled water, and the other end to hot water. This body is designed to integrate the use of two different control valves into one body and one actuator head. There are two connections in the center of the body in Figure 25 that represent supply and return to the coil The applications are mainly chilled beams, radiant ceiling panels, and four-pipe fan-coil units. A single control signal throttles the control valve to operate two flow sequences (cooling/heating) for a single coil with one 90° rotary actuator. Several manufacturers have designed six-way control valves, which can save material and installation time compared to the need of installing two different control valves, one each for heating and cooling.

6. SAFETY DEVICES

The terms safety valve, relief valve, and safety relief valve are sometimes used interchangeably, and although the devices generally provide a similar function (safety), they have important differences in their modes of operation and application in HVAC systems (Jordan 1998).

Safety valves open rapidly (pop-action). They are used for gases and vapors (e.g., compressed air and steam).

Relief valves open or close gradually in proportion to excessive pressure. They are used for liquids (e.g., unheated water).

Safety relief valves perform a dual function: they open rapidly (pop-action) for gases and vapors and gradually for liquids. Typical HVAC application is for heating water.

Temperature-actuated pressure relief valves (or temperature and pressure safety relief valves) are activated by excessive temperature or pressure. They are commonly used for potable hot water.

Application of these safety devices must comply with building codes and the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*. For the remainder of this discussion, the term "safety valve" is used generically to include any or all of the four types described.

Safety valve construction, capacities, limitations, operation, and repair are covered by the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*. For pressures above 100 kPa (gage), refer to Section I. Section IV covers steam boilers for pressures less than 100 kPa (gage). Unfired pressure vessels (such as heat exchange process equipment or pressure-reducing valves) are covered by Section VIII.

The capacity of a safety valve is affected by the equipment on which it is installed and the applicable code. Valves are chosen based on accumulation, which is the pressure increase above the maximum allowable working pressure of the vessel during valve discharge. Section I valves are based on 3% accumulation. Accumulation may be as high as 33.3% for Section IV valves and 10% for Section VIII. To properly size a safety valve, the required capacity and set pressure must be known. On a pressure-reducing valve station, the safety valve must have sufficient capacity to prevent an unsafe pressure rise if the reducing valve fails in the open position.

The safety valve set pressure should be high enough to allow the valve to remain closed during normal operation, yet allow it to open and reseat tightly when cycling. A minimum differential of 35 kPa or 10% of inlet pressure (whichever is greater) is recommended.

When installing a safety valve, consider the following:

- Install the valve vertically with the drain holes open or piped to drain.
- The seat can be distorted if the valve is overtight or the weight of the discharge piping is carried by the valve body. A drip-pan elbow on the discharge of the safety valve prevents the weight of the discharge piping from resting on the valve (Figure 26).
- Use a moderate amount of pipe thread lubricant (first two to three threads) on male threads only.
- Install clean flange connections with new gaskets, properly aligned and parallel, and bolted with even torque to prevent distortion.
- Wire cable or chain pulls attached to the test levers should allow for a vertical pull, and their weight should not be carried by the valve.

Testing of safety valves varies between facilities depending on operating conditions. Under normal conditions, safety valves with a working pressure under 2.8 MPa should be tested manually once per month and pressure-tested once each year. For higher pressures, the test frequency should be based on operating experience.

When steam safety valves require repair, adjustment, or set pressure change, the manufacturer or approved stations holding the ASME V, UV, and/or VR stamps must perform the work. Only the manufacturer is allowed to repair Section IV valves.

7. SELF-CONTAINED TEMPERATURE CONTROL VALVES

Self-contained or self-operated temperature control valves do not require an outside energy source such as compressed air or electricity (Figure 27). They depend on a temperature-sensing bulb and capillary tube filled with either an oil or a volatile liquid. In an **oil-filled** system, the oil expands as the sensing bulb is heated. This expansion is transmitted through the capillary tube to an actuator bellows in the valve top, which causes the valve to close. The valve

opens as the sensing bulb cools and the oil contracts; a spring provides a return force on the valve stem.

A volatile-liquid control system is known as a **vapor pressure** or **vapor tension** system. When the sensing bulb is warmed, some of the volatile liquid vaporizes, causing an increase in the sealed system pressure. The pressure rise is transmitted through the capillary tube to expand the bellows, which then moves the valve stem and closes the valve. Thermal systems actuate the control valve either directly or through a pilot valve.

In a **direct-actuated** design, the control directly moves the valve stem and plug to close or open the valve. These valves must compensate for the steam pressure force acting on the valve seat by generating a greater force in the bellows to close the valve. An adjustable spring adjusts the temperature set point and provides the return force to move the valve stem upward as the temperature decreases.

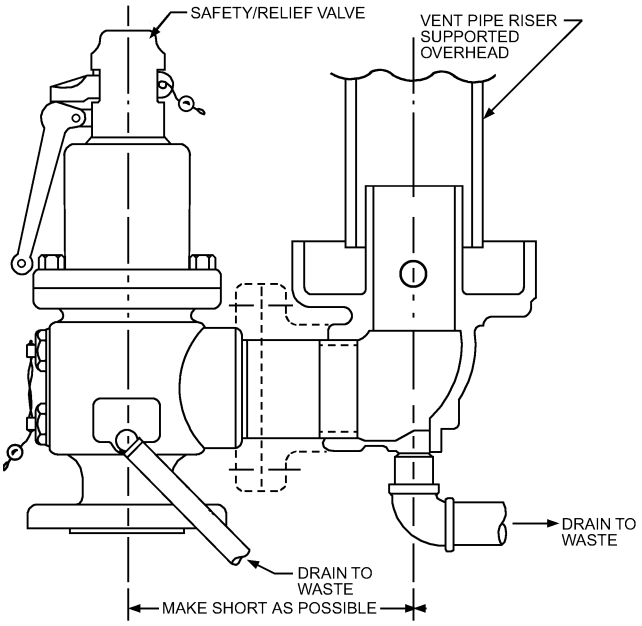

Fig. 26 Safety/Relief Valve with Drip-Pan Elbow

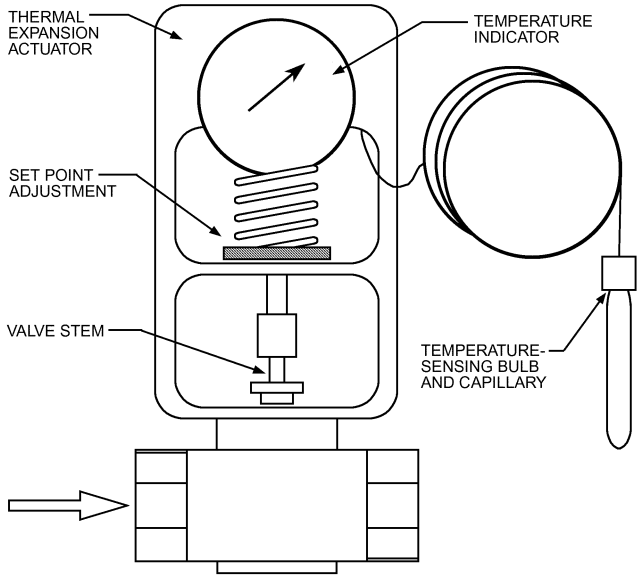

Fig. 27 Self-Operated Temperature Control Valve

A **pilot-operated valve** (Figure 28) uses a much smaller intermediate pilot valve that controls the flow of steam to a large diaphragm that then acts on the valve stem. This allows the control system to work against high steam pressures caused by the smaller area of the pilot valve.

For self-contained temperature valves to operate as proportional controls, the bulb must sense a change in the temperature of the process fluid. The difference in temperature from no-load to maximum controllable load is known as the **proportional band**. Because the size of this proportional band can be varied depending on valve size, the accuracy is variable. Depending on the application, proportional bands of 1 to 10 K may be selected, as shown in the following table:

Application	Proportional Band, K
Domestic hot-water heat exchanger	3 to 8
Central hot water	2 to 4
Space heating	1 to 3
Bulk storage	2 to 10

Although their response time, accuracy, and ease of adjustment may not be as good as those of electrically or pneumatically actuated valves, self-contained steam temperature controls are widely accepted for many applications.

8. PRESSURE-REDUCING VALVES

Should steam pressure be too high for a specific process, a self-contained pressure-reducing valve (PRV) may be used to reduce this pressure, which will also increase the available latent heat. These valves may be direct acting or pilot operated (see Figure 27), much like temperature control valves. To maintain set pressure, the downstream pressure must be sensed either through an internal port or an external line.

The amount of pressure drop below the set pressure that causes the valve to react to a load change is called **droop**. As a general rule, pilot-operated valves have less droop than direct-acting types. To properly size these valves, only the mass flow of steam, the inlet pressure, and the required outlet pressure must be known. Valve line size can be determined by consulting manufacturers' capacity charts.

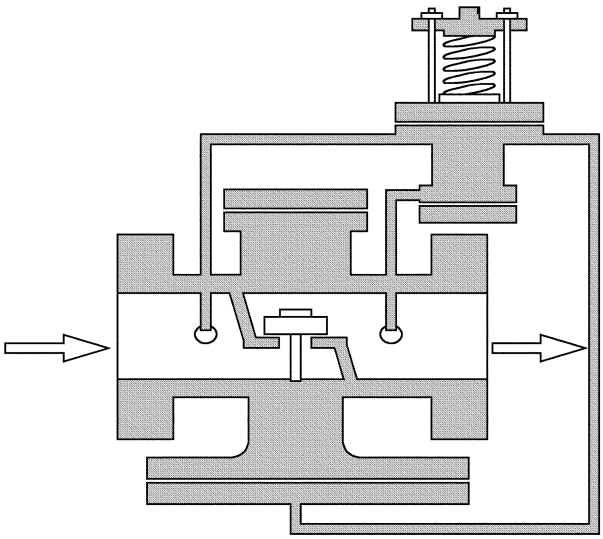

Fig. 28 Pilot-Operated Steam Valve

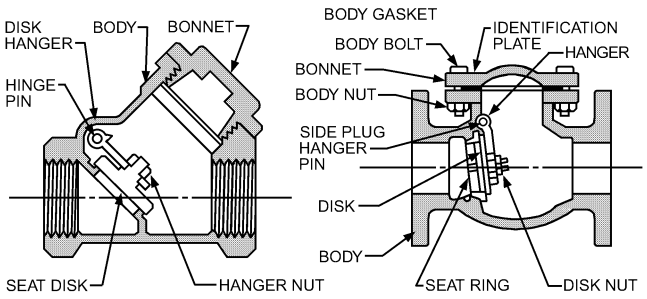

Fig. 29 Swing Check Valves

(Courtesy Anvil International)

Because of their construction, simplicity, accuracy, and ease of installation and maintenance, these valves have been specified for most steam-reducing stations.

Makeup Water Valves

A pressure-reducing valve is normally provided on a hydronic heating or cooling system to automatically fill the system with domestic or city water to maintain a minimum system pressure. This valve may be referred to as a fill valve, PRV fill valve, or automatic PRV makeup water valve, and is usually located at or near the system expansion tank. Local plumbing codes may require a backflow prevention device where the city water connects to the building hydronic system (see the section on Backflow Prevention Devices).

9. CHECK VALVES

Check valves prevent reversal of flow, controlling the direction of flow rather than stopping or starting flow. Some basic types include swing check, ball check, wafer check, silent check, and stop-check valves. Most check valves are available in screwed and flanged body styles.

Swing check valves have hinge-mounted disks that open and close with flow (Figure 29). The seats are generally made of metal, whereas the disks may be of metallic or nonmetallic composition materials. Nonmetallic disks are recommended for fluids containing dirt particles or where tighter shutoff is required. The Y-pattern check valve has an access opening to allow cleaning and regrinding in place. Pressure drop through swing check valves is lower than that through lift check valves because of the straight-through design. Weight- or spring-loaded lever arm check valves are available to limit objectionable slamming or chattering when pulsating flows are encountered.

Lift check valves have a body similar in design to a globe or angle valve body with a similar disk seating. The guided valve disk is forced open by the flow and closes when flow reverses. Because of the body design, the pressure drop is higher than that of a swing check valve. Lift check valves are recommended for gas or compressed air or in fluid systems not having critical pressure drops.

Ball check valves are similar to lift checks, except that they use a ball rather than a disk to accomplish closure. Some ball checks are specifically designed for horizontal flow or vertical upflow installation.

Wafer check valves are designed to fit between pipe flanges similar to butterfly valves and are used in larger piping (100 mm diameter and larger). Wafer check valves have two basic designs: (1) dual spring-loaded flapper, which operates on a hinged center post, and (2) single flapper, which is similar to the swing check valve.

In **silent or spring-loaded check valves**, a spring positively and rapidly closes a guided, floating disk. This valve greatly reduces water hammer, which may occur with slow-closing check valves like the swing check. Silent check valves are recommended for use in pump discharge lines.

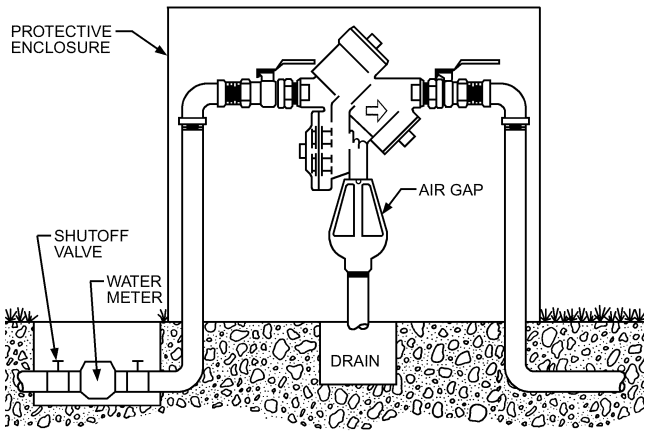

Fig. 30 Backflow Prevention Device

10. STOP-CHECK VALVES

Stop-check valves can operate as both a check valve and a stop valve. The valve stem does not connect to the guided seat plug, allowing the plug to operate as a conventional lift check valve when the stem is in the raised position. Screwing the stem down can limit the valve opening or close the valve. Stop-check valves are used for shutoff service on multiple steam boiler installations, in accordance with the ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code*, to prevent backflow of steam or condensate from an operating boiler to a shutdown boiler. They are mandatory in some jurisdictions. Local codes should be consulted.

11. BACKFLOW PREVENTION DEVICES

Backflow prevention devices prevent reverse flow of the supply in a water system. A **vacuum breaker** prevents back siphonage in a non-pressure system, whereas a **backflow preventer** prevents backflow in a pressurized system (Figure 30).

Selection

Vacuum breakers and backflow preventers should be selected on the basis of the local plumbing codes, the water supply impurities involved, and the type of cross-connection.

Impurities are classified as (1) contaminants (substances that could create a health hazard if introduced into potable water) and (2) pollutants (substances that could create objectionable conditions but not a health hazard).

Cross-connections are classified as non-pressure or pressure connections. In a non-pressure cross-connection, a potable-water pipe connects or extends below the overflow or rim of a receptacle at atmospheric pressure. When this type of connection is not protected by a minimum air gap, it should be protected by an appropriate vacuum breaker or an appropriate backflow preventer.

In a pressure cross-connection, a potable-water pipe is connected to a closed vessel or a piping system that is above atmospheric pressure and contains a nonpotable fluid. This connection should be protected by an appropriate backflow preventer only. Note that a pressure vacuum breaker should not be used alone with a pressure cross-connection.

Vacuum breakers should be corrosion-resistant. Backflow preventers, including accessories, components, and fittings that are 50 mm and smaller, should be made of bronze with threaded connections. Those larger than 50 mm should be made of bronze, gal-

vanized iron, or fused epoxy-coated iron inside and out, with flanged connections. All backflow prevention devices should meet applicable standards of the American National Standards Institute, the Canadian Standards Association, or the required local authorities.

Installation

Vacuum breakers and backflow preventers equipped with atmospheric vents, or with relief openings, should be installed and located to prevent any vent or relief opening from being submerged. They should be installed in the position recommended by the manufacturer.

Backflow preventers may be double check valve (DCV) or reduced pressure zone (RPZ) types. Refer to manufacturers' information for specific application recommendations and code compliance.

12. STEAM TRAPS

For a description and diagram of these traps, see Chapter 11.

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CHAPTER 47

HEAT EXCHANGERS

Fundamentals 47.1
Types of Heat Exchangers 47.1
Components 47.4
Application 47.5
Selection Criteria 47.5
Installation 47.6

HEAT EXCHANGERS transfer heat from one fluid to another without the fluids coming in direct contact with each other. Heat transfer occurs in a heat exchanger when a fluid changes from a liquid to a vapor (evaporator), a vapor to a liquid (condenser), or when two fluids transfer heat without a phase change. The transfer of energy is caused by a temperature difference.

In most HVAC&R applications, heat exchangers are selected to transfer either sensible or latent heat. Sensible heat applications involve transfer of heat from one liquid to another. Latent heat transfer results in a phase change of one of the liquids; transferring heat to a liquid by condensing steam is a common example.

This chapter describes some of the fundamentals, types, components, applications, selection criteria, and installation of heat exchangers. Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* covers the subject of heat transfer. Specific applications of heat exchangers are detailed in other chapters of this and other volumes of the Handbook series.

1. FUNDAMENTALS

When heat is exchanged between two fluids flowing through a heat exchanger, the rate of heat transferred may be calculated using

$$Q = UA\Delta t_m \tag{1}$$

where

U = overall coefficient of heat transfer from fluid to fluid
A = heat transfer area of the heat exchanger associated with U
Δt_m = log mean temperature difference (LMTD)

For a heat exchanger with a constant U, the Δt_m is calculated as

$$\Delta t_m = C_{fx} \frac{(T_1 - t_2) - (T_2 - t_1)}{\ln[(T_1 - t_2)/(T_2 - t_1)]} \tag{2}$$

where the temperature distribution is as shown in Figure 1 and C_{fx} is a correction factor (less than 1.0) that is applied to heat exchanger configurations that do not follow a true counterflow design.

Figure 1 shows a **temperature cross**, where the outlet temperature of the heating fluid is less than the outlet temperature of the fluid being heated ($T_2 < t_2$). A temperature cross can only be obtained with a heat exchanger that has a 100% true counterflow arrangement.

The overall coefficient U is affected by the physical arrangement of the surface area A. For a given load, not all heat exchangers with equal surface areas perform equally. For this reason, load conditions must be defined when selecting a heat exchanger for a specific application.

The load for each fluid stream can be calculated as

$$Q = mc_p(t_{in} - t_{out}) \tag{3}$$

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.1, Hydronic and Steam Equipment and Systems.

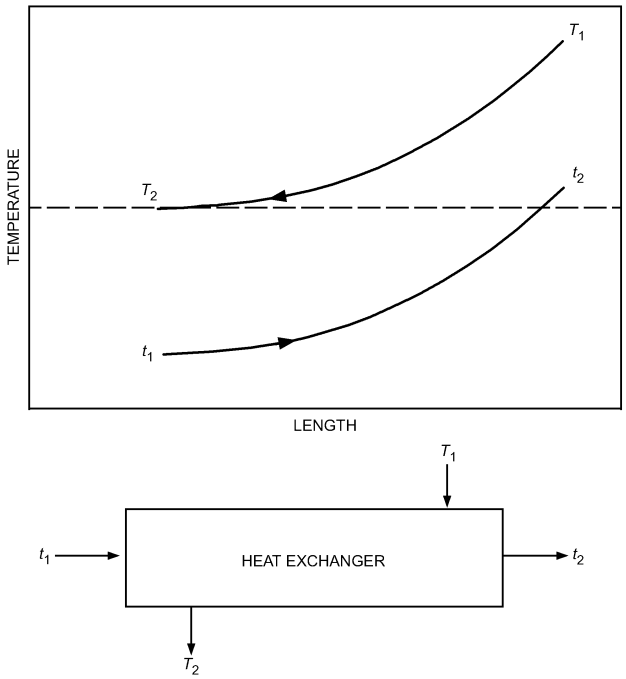


Fig. 1 Temperature Distribution in Counterflow Heat Exchanger

The value of Δt_m is an important factor in heat exchanger selection. If the value Δt_m is high, a relatively small heat exchange surface area is required for a given load. The economic effect is that the heat exchanger must be designed to accommodate the forces and movements associated with large temperature differences. When the **approach temperature** (the difference between T_2 and t_1) is small, Δt_m is also small and a relatively large A is required.

Chapter 4 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* describes an alternative method of evaluating heat exchanger performance that involves the exchanger heat transfer effectiveness ε and number of exchanger transfer units (NTU). This method is based on the same assumptions as the logarithmic mean temperature difference method described previously.

2. TYPES OF HEAT EXCHANGERS

Most heat exchangers for HVAC&R applications are counterflow shell-and-tube or plate units. Although both types physically separate the fluids transferring heat, their construction is very different, and each has unique application and performance qualities.

Shell-and-Tube Heat Exchangers

Figure 2 shows the counterflow path of a shell-and-tube heat exchanger. The fluid at temperature T_1 enters one end of the shell, flows outside the tubes and inside the shell, and exits at the other

end at temperature T_2. The other fluid flows inside the tubes, entering one end at temperature t_1 and exiting at the opposite end at temperature t_2.

In a shell-and-tube heat exchanger, a tube bundle assembly is welded or bolted inside a tubular shell. The bundle is constructed of metal tubes mechanically rolled or welded at one (U-tube) or both ends (straight-tube) into tubesheet(s) that function as headers. The shell is usually a length of pipe that has inlet and outlet connections located along one or more of its longitudinal centerlines.

The shell is flanged at one or both open ends to accommodate a head assembly. The tube bundle is positioned between the shell and head assemblies so that the tube wall of the bundle mechanically separates the two flow paths.

The tube bundle is assembled with tube supports, which are held together with tie rods and spacers. Units with liquid on the shell side have baffles for tube supports that direct the flow. Condensers must have baffles that have been notched on the bottom to allow the liquid condensate to flow freely to the exit nozzle.

The head assembly directs the other fluid across the tubesheet(s) into and out of the tube bundle. Head assemblies are designed with pass partitions to isolate sections of the tube bundle such that the fluid must traverse the length of the unit one, two, four, or more times before exiting.

One of two types of head assemblies is mechanically attached to the shell. Units with multiple tube-side pass construction have a head with both an inlet and outlet connection bolted at one end with a welded cap (U-tube) or bolted reversing head (straight-tube) at the opposite shell end. Single-pass units have an inlet head attached at one shell end and an outlet head attached at the other end.

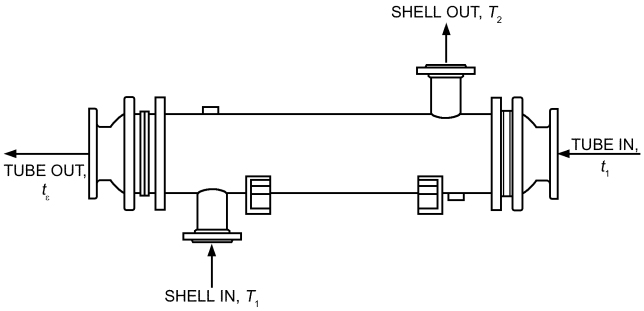


Fig. 2 Counterflow Path in Shell-and-Tube Heat Exchanger

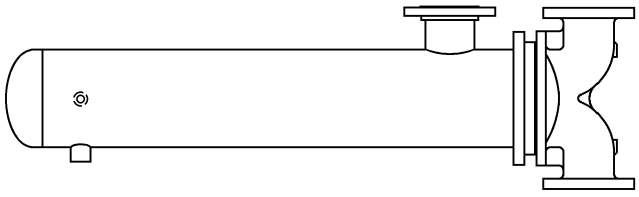


Fig. 3 U-Tube Shell-and-Tube Heat Exchanger with Removable Bundle Assembly and Cast K-Pattern Flanged Head

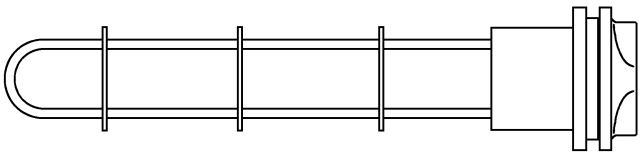


Fig. 4 U-Tube Tank Heater with Removable Bundle Assembly and Cast Bonnet Head

Many variations of the shell-and-tube design are available, some of which are described in the following paragraphs.

U-Tube. Figure 3 shows a U-tube removable-bundle shell-and-tube heat exchanger. These units are commonly called **converters**. Figures 4 and 5 depict modifications of the U-tube design.

Tank heaters are U-tube heat exchangers with the shell replaced by a mounting collar welded to a tank. A hot fluid or steam flows inside the tubes, heating the fluid in the tank by natural convection. The tank heater manufacturer should be consulted about optimizing the bundle length. Although it is desirable for the bundle to significantly extend into the tank, the designer must consider the need for additional bundle support.

Tank suction heaters differ from tank heaters because they have an additional opening that allows fluid being heated to be pumped across the outside tube wall, improving thermal performance.

Straight-Tube. Figures 6 and 7 show two common designs of straight-tube, shell-and-tube exchangers, one with a fixed and the other with a removable tube bundle assembly.

Some straight-tube, shell-and-tube heat exchangers have a floating head bolted with a gasket to a floating tubesheet or a shell-side expansion joint. This configuration is expensive and is rarely specified in HVAC applications.

Shell-and-Coil. The tubes in this heat exchanger are coiled in a helical configuration around a small core. A spacer is placed between the tube layers. In some designs the tubes have an oval cross section. These heat exchangers are very compact and have a relatively large surface area for their size. Figure 5 in Chapter 42 shows a shell-and-coil heat exchanger.

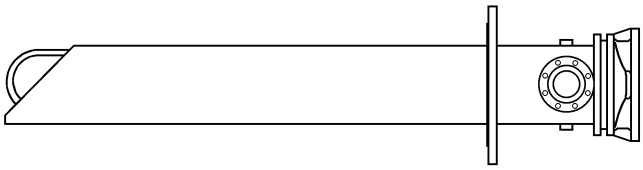


Fig. 5 U-Tube Tank Suction Heater with Removable Bundle Assembly and Cast Flanged Head

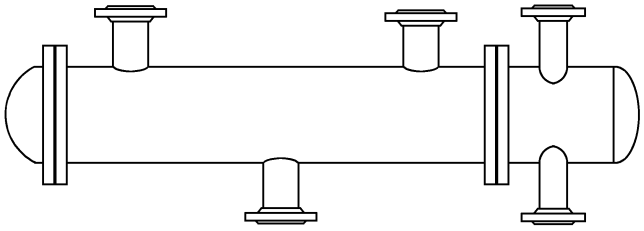


Fig. 6 Straight-Tube Fixed Tubesheet Shell-and-Tube Heat Exchanger with Fabricated Bonnet Heads and Split-Shell Flow Design

Fig. 7 Straight-Tube Floating Tubesheet Shell-and-Tube Heat Exchanger with Removable Bundle Assembly and Fabricated Channel Heads

Tube-in-Tube Heat Exchanger

Tube-in-tube heat exchange functions similarly to shell-and-tube heat exchange. This uses a smaller single tube enclosed in an outer shell (tube). The inner tube can be either smooth or corrugated. The tubes are aligned coaxially. The heat exchanger can consist of a single pair, or multiple pairs in parallel.

Single tube-in-tube heat exchangers use a tee as the header (see Figure 30 in Chapter 1 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*). The tee's annular space around the inner tube is sealed using a crimp, fitting, or bushing; welded; or soldered. Multiple parallel tube-in-tube heat exchangers use a fully welded header, or a header with built-in thermal expansion protection using O-rings or packing. Tube-in-tube heat exchanger shapes include straight, curved, and helical.

Applications include water-to-water heat recovery, high-temperature and -pressure applications, use with fluids containing fiber and small particles, food processing, sewage sludge heating, refrigeration, and effluent water cooling and heat recovery.

Plate Heat Exchangers

Plate heat exchangers consist of metal plate pairs arranged to provide separate flow paths (channels) for two fluids. Heat transfer occurs across the plate walls. The exchangers have multiple channels that are mounted on a frame and clamped together. The rectangular plates have an opening or port at each corner. When assembled, the plates are sealed so that the ports provide manifolds to distribute fluids through the separate flow paths. Figure 8 shows the flow paths.

The multiple plates, called a **plate pack**, are supported by a carrying bar and contained by pressure plates at each end. This design allows the units to be opened for maintenance or addition or removal of plate pairs. The adjoining plates are gasketed, welded, or brazed together.

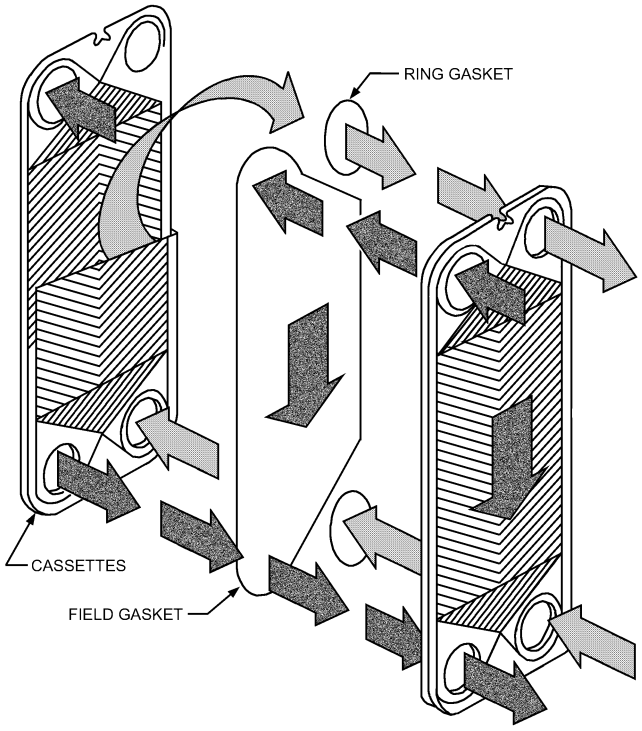


Fig. 8 Flow Path of Gasketed-Plate Heat Exchanger

Gasketed-plate heat exchangers are typically limited to design pressures of 2 MPa. The type of gasket material used limits the operating temperature. Brazed-plate units are designed for pressures up to 3 MPa and temperatures up to 260°C.

Gasketed. The most common plate heat exchanger is the gasketed-plate unit. Typically, nitrile butyl rubber (NBR) gaskets are used in applications up to 110°C. Ethylene-propylene terpolymer (EPDM) gaskets are available for temperatures up to 160°C. The gaskets are glued or clipped onto the plates. The gasket pattern on each plate creates the counterflow paths illustrated in Figure 8.

Semiwelded. Two plates can be welded together at the edges into an assembly called a **cassette**. This flow channel contains fluids when appropriate gasket material is not available such as for handling corrosive fluids. The channels containing the nonaggressive fluids are sealed with standard gaskets. Semiwelded units can also be used for refrigeration applications. Figure 9 shows the flow path of a welded-plate heat exchanger.

Brazed. Brazed-plate heat exchangers have neither gaskets nor frames (Figure 10). They consist of plates brazed together with a copper or nickel flux. This design can be very cost effective in closed-system applications where lack of maintenance is not a concern.

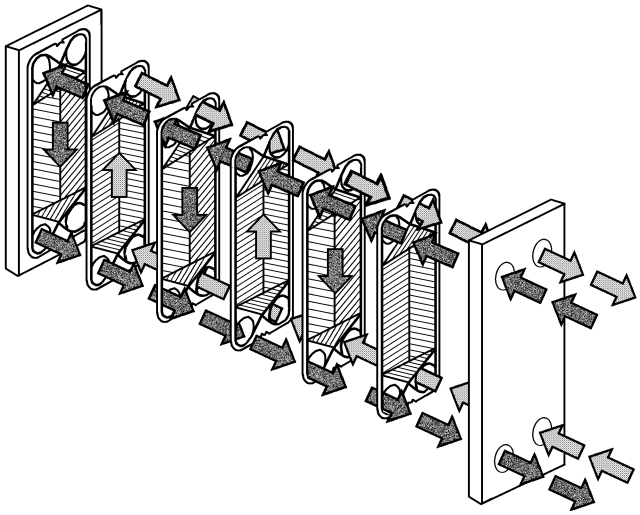


Fig. 9 Flow Path of Welded-Plate Heat Exchanger

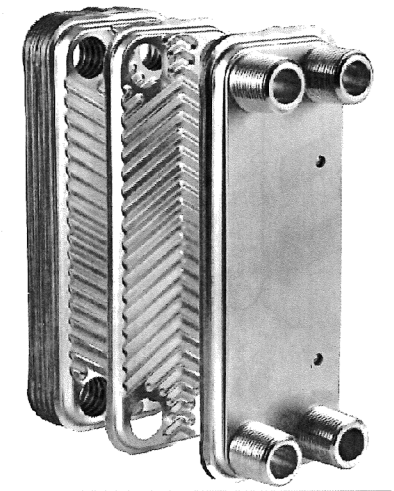


Fig. 10 Brazed-Plate Heat Exchanger

Fig. 11 Double-Wall Tube

(Courtesy Bell & Gossett)

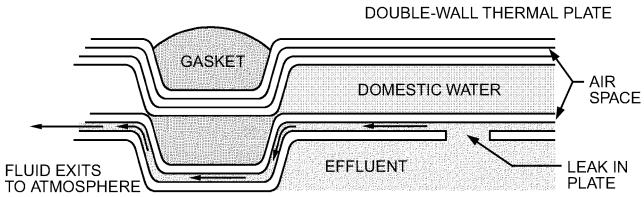


Fig. 12 Double-Wall Plate Cassette for Gasketed Plate and Frame Exchanger

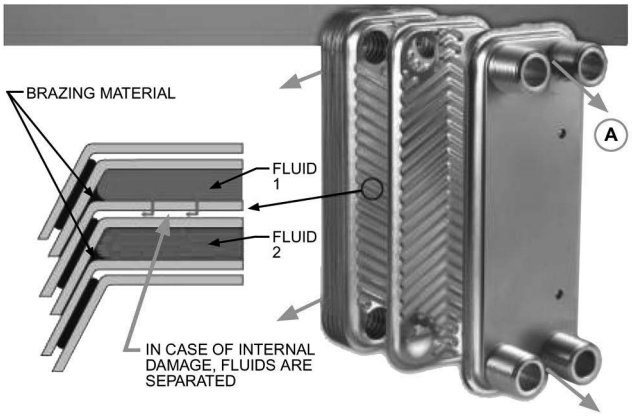


Fig. 13 Double-Wall Plate Assembly with Brazed-Plate Exchanger

(Courtesy Bell & Gossett)

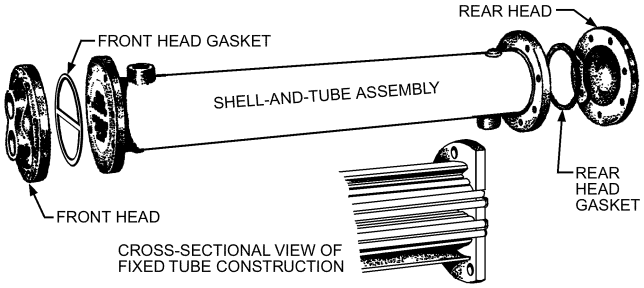


Fig. 14 Exploded View of Straight-Tube Heat Exchanger

Double-Wall Heat Exchangers

Double-wall heat exchangers have a leakage path that warns of mechanical failure before fluids can be cross contaminated. Both shell-and-tube and plate heat exchangers are available. The overall thermal performance of a double-wall unit is less than a comparable single-wall design. Double-wall units cost significantly more than single-wall units.

A double-wall tube (Figure 11) consists of a tube-in-tube design fabricated into double tubesheets. The outer tube is rolled into the inner tubesheet. The inner tube is finned or has grooves cut in it. It is rolled into the outer tubesheet to provide a vented leak path between tubesheets to provide a visible indication of a failure of either tube.

A double-wall plate for a gasketed plate-and-frame heat exchanger (Figure 12) is constructed by welding two standard channel plates together at the four port openings to form a leak path between the plates should a plate fail.

Similarly, a double-wall plate for a brazed-plate heat exchanger (Figure 13) is constructed by brazing two special plates together while maintaining a leak path should the plate fail.

3. COMPONENTS

Heat exchangers for HVAC applications should be constructed and labeled according to the applicable ASME *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* and rated for 1000 kPa at 190°C. Heat exchangers operating at elevated temperatures or pressures require special construction.

Shell-and-Tube Components

Figure 14 shows the various components of a shell-and-tube exchanger, including the following:

- **Shells** are usually made of steel pipe; brass and stainless steel are also used. The inlet and outlet nozzles can be made with standard flange openings in various orientations to suit piping needs. The nozzles are sized to avoid excessive fluid velocity and impingement on the tubes opposite a shell inlet connection.
- **Baffles, tube supports, tie rods, and spacers** are usually made of steel; brass and stainless steel are also available. The number and spacing of baffles controls the velocity and, therefore, a significant portion of the shell-side heat transfer coefficient and pressure drop.
- **Tubes** are usually made of copper; special grades of brass and stainless steel can be specified. The tube diameter, gage, and material affect the heat transfer coefficient and performance.
- **Tubesheets** are available in the same materials as baffles, although the materials do not have to be the same in a given heat exchanger. Tubesheets are drilled for a specific tube layout called **pitch**. The holes are sometimes serrated to improve the tube-to-tubesheet joint.
- **Heads** are usually cast iron or fabricated steel. Cast brass and cast stainless steel are available in limited sizes. Heads can be custom fabricated in most metals. The inlet and outlet nozzles can be made with standard flange openings. Figures 3, 4, and 5 show three different head configurations that offer different levels of serviceability and ease of installation.

Plate Components

Figure 15 shows the various components of a gasketed plate and frame heat exchanger. The materials of construction and purpose of the components are as follows:

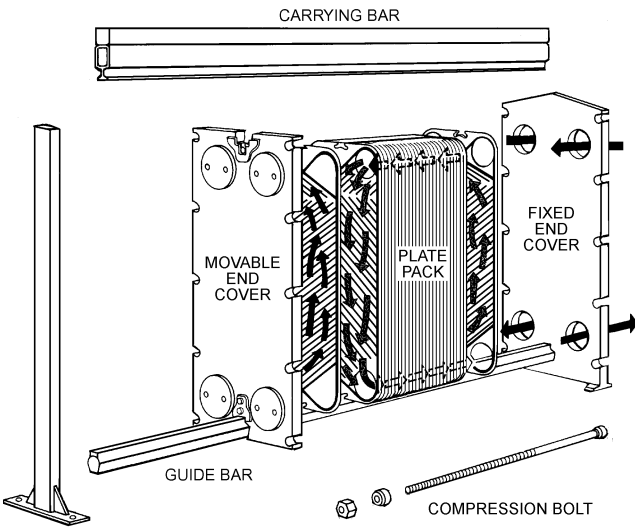


Fig. 15 Components of a Gasketed Plate Heat Exchanger

- **Fixed frame plates** are usually made of carbon steel. Single-pass units have inlet and outlet connections for both fluids located on the fixed frame plate. Connections are usually NPT or stud port design to accommodate ANSI flanges. NPT connections are carbon steel or stainless steel. Stud port connections can be lined with metallic or rubber-type materials to protect against corrosion.
- **Movable pressure plates** can be moved along the length of the carrying bar to allow removal, replacement, or addition of plates. They are made of carbon steel. Multiple-pass units have some connections located on the movable pressure plate.
- **Plate packs** are made up of multiple heat transfer (channel) plates and gaskets. Plates are made of pressable metals, such as 316 or 304 stainless steel or titanium. They are formed with corrugations, typically in a herringbone or chevron pattern. The angle of these patterns affects the thermal performance and pressure drop of a given flow channel.
- **Compression bolts** compress the plate back between the movable pressure and fixed frame plates. The dimension between the two is critical and is specified by the unit manufacturer for a given plate pack configuration.
- **Carrying and guide bars** support and align the channel plates. The upper bar is called a carrying bar, the lower a guide bar. They are made of stainless steel, aluminum, or carbon steel with zinc chromate finish.
- **Support columns** support the carrying and guide bars on larger plate heat exchangers.
- **Splashguards** are required in the United States by OSHA to enclose exterior channel plate and gasket surfaces. They are usually formed from aluminum.
- **Drip pans** made of stainless steel are often installed under plate heat exchangers to contain leakage on start-up or shut down, gasket failure, or condensation.

4. APPLICATION

Heat exchangers are used when the primary energy source is available for multiple purposes, uses a different medium, or its temperature or pressure is not in the design limits. Most of the following examples are discussed in other chapters and volumes of the *ASHRAE Handbook*. Heat exchangers are used

- To condense steam from a boiler to produce hot water for central water systems
- For service water for potable and nonpotable applications, which is often heated by a converter and hot-water or steam boilers, with or without a storage tank
- To meet special temperature requirements of parts of a system or to protect against freezing in isolated terminal units (coils) and cooling tower basins
- To isolate two systems operating at different pressures while transferring thermal energy between them
- In energy-saving applications such as condensate cooling, vent condensing, boiler blowdown, thermal storage, and chiller bypass (free cooling)
- In many refrigeration applications as evaporators, condensers, and liquid coolers

5. SELECTION CRITERIA

A heat exchanger is often selected by a computer program that optimizes the selection for the given design. A manufacturer should provide detailed selection guidance for both a shell-and-tube and plate exchanger for a given set of conditions. The following list of typical information should be provided to the manufacturer:

- Type of heat exchanger
- Mass flow rates of the hot and cold media
- Inlet temperatures of the hot and cold media
- Outlet temperatures of the hot and cold media
- Steam pressure (if applicable)
- Whether potable water is used
- Any special conditions, such as length, diameter, clearances, water quality, fouling factor, etc.

Thermal/Mechanical Design

Shell-and-tube heat exchangers are designed first to be pressure vessels and second to transfer heat. Plate heat exchangers are designed to transfer heat efficiently within certain temperature and pressure limits.

Thermal Performance. The thermal performance of a heat exchanger is a function of the size and geometry of the heat transfer surface area. Heat transfer surface materials also affect performance; for instance, copper has a higher coefficient of heat transfer than stainless steel.

Flow rates (velocity), viscosity, and thermal conductivity of the fluids are significant factors in determining the overall heat transfer coefficient U. In addition, the fluid to be heated should be on the tube side because the overall U of a shell-and-tube unit is often reduced if the fluid to be heated is on the shell side.

Properly selected shell-and-tube heat exchangers use tube pass options and shell-side baffle spacing to maximize velocity (turbulence) without causing tube erosion. The ability to maximize velocity on each side of a heat exchanger is particularly important when the two fluids' flow rates are dissimilar. However, fluid velocity in the shell-and-tube heat exchanger is limited to avoid tube erosion. U-tube exchangers have lower tube-side velocity limits than straight-tube units due to the thinner tube wall in the U bends.

Shell-and-tube heat exchangers can be constructed for split-shell flow design (see Figure 6) to accommodate unusual conditions. These units have one shell inlet connection and two outlet connections.

Plate heat exchangers typically have U-factors three to five times higher than shell-and-tube heat exchangers. The high turbulence created by the corrugated plate design increases convection and increases the U-factor. The plate design achieves a large temperature cross at a 1 K approach because of the counterflow fluid path and high U-factor.

Thermal Stress. Heat exchangers must accommodate the thermal stresses associated with large temperature differences. U-tube

units offer superior economic performance over straight-tube units with removable tube bundles under extreme conditions. Units with fixed tubesheets do not handle large temperature differences well.

Gasketed plate units have a **differential pressure/temperature limitation (DPTL)**, which is the maximum difference in operating pressure of the two fluids at a specific temperature. A unit rated for 2 MPa at 125°C might have a DPTL of 1.5 MPa at 95°C.

Pressure Drop. Fluid velocity and normal limitations on tube length tend to result in relatively low pressure drops in shell-and-tube heat exchangers. Plate units tend to have larger pressure drops unless the velocity is limited. Often a pressure drop limitation rather than a thermal performance requirement determines the surface area in a plate unit.

Fouling. Often, excess surface area is specified to allow for scale accumulation on heat transfer surfaces without a significant reduction of performance. This fouling factor or allowance is applied when sizing the unit. Fouling allowance is better specified as a percentage of excess area rather than as a resistance to heat transfer.

Shell-and-tube exchangers with properly sized tubes can handle suspended solids better than plate units with narrow flow channels. The high fluid velocity and turbulence in plate exchangers make them less susceptible to fouling.

The addition of surface area (tube length) to a shell-and-tube exchanger does not affect fluid velocity, and, therefore, has little effect on thermal performance. This characteristic makes a fouling allowance practical. This is not the case in plate units, for which the number of parallel flow channels determines velocity. This means that as plate pairs are added to meet a load (heat transfer surface area) requirement, the number of channels increases and results in decreased fluid velocity. This lower velocity reduces performance and requires additional plate pairs, which further reduces performance.

Cost

On applications with temperature crosses and close approaches, plate heat exchangers usually have the lowest initial cost. Wide temperature approaches often favor shell-and-tube units. If the application requires stainless steel, the plate unit may be more economical.

Maintenance

Shell-and-tube heat exchangers have different degrees of serviceability. The type of header used facilitates access to the inside of the tubes. The heads shown in Figures 3, 6, and 7 can be easily removed without special pipe arrangements. The tube bundles in the shell-and-tube units shown, except the fixed-tubesheet unit (Figure 6), can be replaced after the head is removed if piped with proper clearance.

The diameter and configuration of the tubes are significant in determining whether the inside of tubes of straight-tube units can be mechanically cleaned. Figure 7 shows a type of head that allows cleaning or inspection inside tubes after the channel cover is removed.

Plate heat exchangers can be serviced by sliding the movable pressure plate back along the carrying bars. Individual plates can be removed for cleaning, regasketing, or replacement. Plate pairs can be added for additional capacity. Complete replacement plate packs can be installed.

Space Requirements

Cost-effective and efficient shell-and-tube heat exchangers have small-diameter, long tubes. This configuration often challenges the designer when allocating space required for service and maintenance. For this reason, many shell-and-tube selections have large diameters and short lengths. Although this selection performs well, it often costs more than a smaller-diameter unit with equal surface area. Be careful to provide adequate maintenance clearance around heat exchangers. For shell-and-tube units, space should be left clear so the tube bundle can be removed.

Plate heat exchangers tend to provide the most compact design in terms of surface area for a given space.

Steam

Most HVAC applications using steam are designed with shell-and-tube units. Plate heat exchangers are used in specialized industrial and food processes with steam.

Water Quality

Ensure that the system's water quality is compatible with the materials used in the construction of the heat exchanger.

6. INSTALLATION

Control. Heat exchangers are usually controlled by a valve with a temperature sensor. The sensor is placed in the flow stream of the fluid to be heated or cooled. The valve regulates flow on the other side of the heat exchanger to achieve the sensor set-point temperature. Chapter 46 discusses control valves.

Piping. Heat exchangers should be piped such that air is easily vented. Pipes must be able to be drained and accessible for service.

Pressure Relief. Safety pressure relief valves should be installed on both sides between the heat exchanger and shutoff valves to guard against damage from thermal expansion when the unit is not in service, as well as to protect against overpressurization.

Flow Path. The intended flow path of each fluid on both sides of a heat exchanger design should be followed. Failure to connect to the correct inlet and outlet connections may reduce performance.

Condensate Removal. Heat exchangers that condense steam require special installation. Proper removal of condensate is particularly important. Inadequate drainage of condensate can result in significant loss of capacity and even in mechanical failure.

Installing a vacuum breaker aids in draining condensate, particularly when modulating steam control valves are used. Properly sized and installed steam traps are critical. Chapter 11 discusses steam traps and condensate removal.

Insulation. Heat exchangers are often insulated. Chapters 23, 25, 26, and 27 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* have further information on insulation.

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

ASHRAE members can access *ASHRAE Journal* articles and ASHRAE research project final reports at technologyportal.ashrae.org. Articles and reports are also available for purchase by nonmembers in the online ASHRAE Bookstore at www.ashrae.org/bookstore.

CHAPTER 48

UNITARY AIR CONDITIONERS AND HEAT PUMPS

General Design Considerations 48.1
Types of Unitary Equipment 48.2
Equipment and System Standards 48.6
Air Conditioners 48.7
Air-Source Heat Pumps 48.9
Water-Source Heat Pumps 48.11
Variable-Refrigerant-Flow Heat Pumps 48.14

UNITARY air conditioners are factory-made assemblies that normally include an evaporator or cooling coil and a compressor/condenser combination, and possibly provide heating as well. An **air-source unitary heat pump** normally includes an indoor conditioning coil, compressor(s), and an outdoor coil. It must provide heating and possibly cooling as well. A **water-source heat pump** rejects or extracts heat to and from a water loop instead of from ambient air. A unitary air conditioner or heat pump with more than one factory-made assembly (e.g., indoor and outdoor units) is commonly called a **split system**.

Unitary equipment is divided into three general categories: residential, light commercial, and commercial. Residential equipment is single-phase unitary equipment with a cooling capacity of 19 kW or less and is designed specifically for residential application. Light commercial equipment is generally three-phase, with cooling capacity up to 40 kW, and is designed for small businesses and commercial properties. Commercial unitary equipment has cooling capacity higher than 40 kW and is designed for large commercial buildings.

1. GENERAL DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

User Requirements

The user primarily needs either space conditioning for occupant comfort or a controlled environment for products or manufacturing processes. Cooling, dehumidification, filtration, and air circulation often meet those needs, although heating, humidification, and ventilation are also required in many applications.

Application Requirements

Unitary equipment is available in many configurations, such as

- **Single-zone, constant-volume**, which consists of one controlled space with one thermostat that controls to maintain a set point. This equipment may be single stage, multistage, or variable capacity.
- **Multizone, constant-volume**, which has several controlled spaces served by one unit that supplies air of different temperatures to different zones as demanded (Figure 1).
- **Single-package, variable-volume**, which consists of several controlled spaces served by one unit. Supply air from the unit is at a constant temperature, with air volume to each space varied to satisfy space demands (Figure 2).
- **Multisplit,** which consists of several controlled spaces, each served by a separate indoor unit. All indoor units are connected to an outdoor condensing unit (Figure 3). When each indoor unit varies its refrigerant flow in response to heating or cooling load demand, the system is called **variable refrigerant flow (VRF)**.

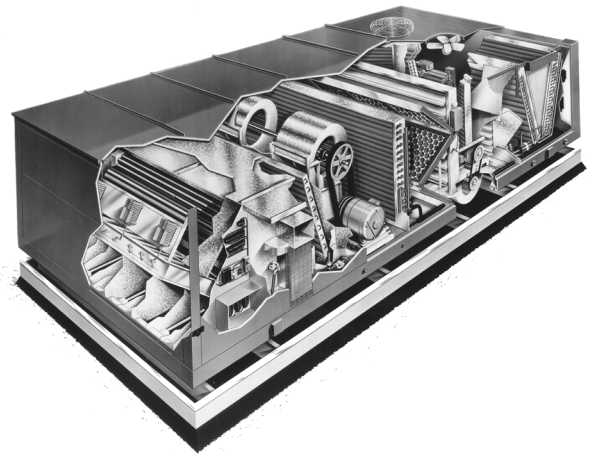


Fig. 1 Typical Rooftop Air-Cooled Single-Package Air Conditioner

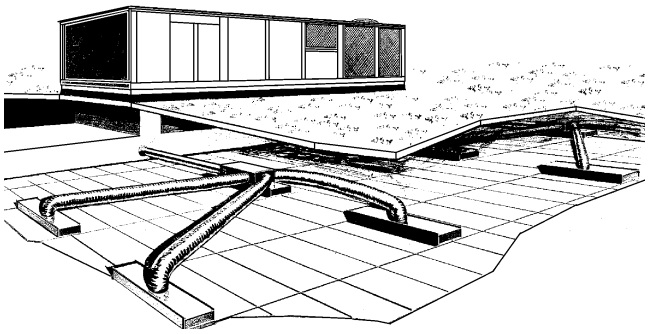


Fig. 2 Single-Package Air Equipment with Variable Air Volume

Factors such as size, shape, and use of the building; availability and cost of energy; building aesthetics (equipment located outdoors); and space available for equipment are considered to determine the type of unitary equipment best suited to a given application. In general, roof-mounted single-package unitary equipment is limited to five or six stories because duct space and available blower power become excessive in taller buildings. Split units are limited by the maximum distance allowed between the indoor and outdoor sections because of losses in refrigerant piping, compressor capability, and refrigerant oil management. Indoor, single-zone equipment is generally less expensive to maintain and service than multizone or multisplit units.

The building load and airflow requirements determine equipment capacity, whereas the availability and cost of fuels determine the

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.11, Unitary and Room Air Conditioners and Heat Pumps.

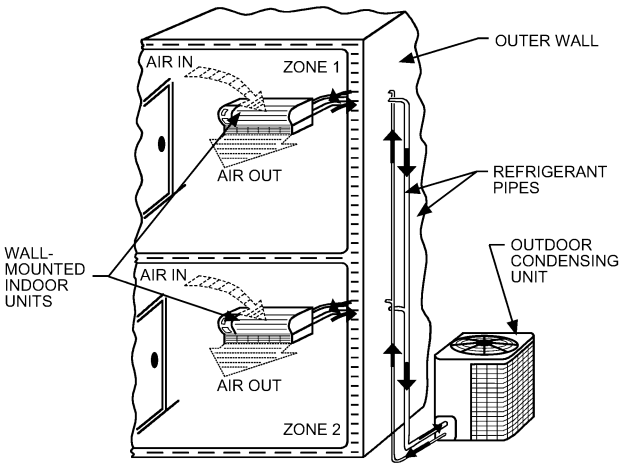


Fig. 3 Example of Two-Zone Ductless Multisplit System in Typical Residential Installation

energy source. Control system requirements must be established, and any unusual operating conditions must be considered early in the planning stage. In some cases, custom-designed equipment may be necessary.

Manufacturers' literature has detailed information about geometry, performance, electrical characteristics, application, and operating limits. The system designer selects suitable equipment with the capacity for the application.

Installation

Unitary equipment is designed to keep installation costs low. Equipment must be installed properly so that it functions in accordance with the manufacturer's specifications. Interconnecting diagrams for the low-voltage control system should be documented for proper future servicing. Adequate planning is important for installing large, roof-mounted equipment because special rigging equipment is frequently required. ACCA *Standard* 5 describes minimum criteria for the proper installation of HVAC systems in residential and commercial installations.

The refrigerant circuit must be clean, dry, and leak-free. An advantage of packaged unitary equipment is that proper installation minimizes the risk of field contamination of the circuit. Care must be taken to properly install split-system interconnecting tubing (e.g., proper cleanliness, brazing, and evacuation to remove moisture and other noncondensables). Split systems should be charged according to the manufacturer's instructions. Filter-driers are necessary; if they are not installed at the factory, they should be field installed.

When installing split, multisplit, and VRF systems, lines must be properly routed and sized to ensure proper oil return to the compressor. Chapters 1 and 2 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* have more details on appropriate refrigerant piping practices.

Unitary equipment must be located to avoid noise and vibration problems. Single-package equipment of over 70 kW capacity should be mounted on concrete pads if vibration control is a concern. Large-capacity equipment should be roof mounted only after the roof's structural adequacy has been evaluated. If they are located over occupied space, roof-mounted units with return fans that use ceiling space for the return plenum should have a lined return plenum according to the manufacturer's recommendations. Use duct silencers where low sound levels are desired. Mass and sound data are available from many manufacturers. Additional installation guidelines include the following:

- In general, install products containing compressors on solid, level surfaces.
- Avoid mounting products containing compressors (such as remote units) on or touching the foundation of a house or building, or outside bedroom windows. A separate pad that does not touch the foundation is recommended to reduce any noise and vibration transmission through the slab.
- Do not box in outdoor air-cooled units with fences, walls, overhangs, or bushes. Doing so reduces the air-moving capability of the unit, reducing efficiency. Manufacturers include minimum clearances in literature.
- For a split-system remote unit, choose an installation site that is close to the indoor part of the system to minimize pressure drop in the connecting refrigerant tubing. Comply with manufacturers' refrigerant line length limits and required accessories listed in their literature.
- For VRF units, locate the refrigerant pipes' headers so that the length of refrigerant pipes is minimized.
- Contact the manufacturer or consult installation instructions for further information on installation procedures.

Unitary equipment should be listed or certified by nationally recognized testing laboratories to ensure safe operation and compliance with government and utility regulations. Equipment should also be installed to comply with agency standards' rating and application requirements to ensure that it performs according to industry criteria. Larger and more specialized equipment often does not carry agency labeling. However, power and control wiring practices should comply with the *National Electrical Code*® (NFPA *Standard* 70). Consult local codes before the installation is designed, and consult local inspectors before installation.

Service

A clear and accurate wiring diagram and well-written service manual are essential to the installer and service personnel. Easy and safe service access must be provided in the equipment for cleaning, lubrication, and periodic maintenance of filters and belts. In addition, access for replacement of major components must be provided and preserved.

Availability of replacement parts aids proper service. Most manufacturers offer warranties covering 1 year of operation after installation. Extended compressor warranties may be standard or optional.

Service personnel must be qualified to repair or replace mechanical and electrical components and to recover and properly recycle or dispose of any refrigerant removed from a system. They must also understand the importance of controlling moisture and other contaminants in the refrigerant circuit; they should know how to clean a hermetic system if it has been opened for service (see Chapter 7 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*). Proper service procedures help ensure that the equipment will continue operating efficiently for its expected life.

Sustainability

Unitary equipment should be properly sized; avoid gross oversizing. Equipment performance should be carefully evaluated at all expected load conditions, and equipment should be selected to achieve the most efficient operation at all expected occupancy conditions. See application-specific chapters in the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for further information on equipment sizing.

2. TYPES OF UNITARY EQUIPMENT

Tables 1 and 2 show available types of unitary air conditioners and unitary heat pumps, respectively. The following variations apply to some types and sizes of unitary equipment.

Arrangement. Major unit components for various unitary air conditioners are arranged as shown in Table 1 and for unitary heat pumps as shown in Table 2.

Table 1 AHRI *Standard* 210/240 Classification of Unitary Air Conditioners

System Designation	AHRI Type*	Heat Rejection	Arrangement
Single package	SP-A	Air	Fan, Comp
	SP-E	Evap Cond	Evap, Cond
	SP-W	Water	
Refrigeration chassis	RCH-A	Air	Comp
	RCH-E	Evap Cond	Evap, Cond
	RCH-W	Water	
Year-round single package	SPY-A	Air	Fan
	SPY-E	Evap Cond	Heat, Comp
	SPY-W	Water	Evap, Cond
Remote condenser	RC-A	Air	Fan
	RC-E	Evap Cond	Evap, Cond
	RC-W	Water	Comp
Year-round remote condenser	RCY-A	Air	Fan
	RCY-E	Evap Cond	Evap, Cond
	RCY-W	Water	Heat
			Comp
Condensing unit, coil alone	RCU-A-C	Air	Evap, Cond
	RCU-E-C	Evap Cond	Comp
	RCU-W-C	Water	
Condensing unit, coil and blower	RCU-A-CB	Air	Fan, Cond
	RCU-E-CB	Evap Cond	Evap, Comp
	RCU-W-CB	Air	
Year-round condensing unit, coil and blower	RCUY-A-CB	Air	Fan
	RCUY-E-CB	Evap Cond	Evap, Cond
	RCUY-W-CB	Water	Heat, Comp

*Adding a suffix of "-O" to any of these classifications indicates equipment not intended for use with field-installed duct systems.

Table 2 AHRI *Standard* 210/240 Classification of Air-Source Unitary Heat Pumps

Designation	AHRI Type*		Arrangement
	Heating and Cooling	Heating Only	
Single package	HSP-A	HOSP-A	Fan, Comp; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil
Remote outdoor coil	HRC-A-CB	HORC-A-CB	Fan; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil; Comp
Remote outdoor coil with no indoor fan	HRC-A-C	HORC-A-C	Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil; Comp
Split system	HRCU-A-CB	HORCU-A-CB	Fan, Comp; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil
Split system, no indoor fan	HRCU-A-C	HORCU-A-C	Comp; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil
Through-the-wall heat pump	TTW-HSP-A	TTW-HOSP-A	Fan, Comp; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil; or; Fan, Comp; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil
	TTW-HRCU-A-C	TTW-HORCU-A-C	
	TTW-HRCU-A-CB	TTW-HORCU-A-CB	
Space-constrained products	SCP-HSP-A	SCP-HOSP-A	Fan, Comp; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil; or; Fan, Comp; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil
	SCP-HRCU-A-C	SCP-HORCU-A-C	
	SCP-HRCU-A-CB	SCP-HORCU-A-CB	
Small-duct, high-velocity system	SDHV-HSP-A	SDHV-HOSP-A	Fan, Comp; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil; or; Fan, Comp; Indoor Coil, Outdoor Coil
	SDHV-HRCU-A-C	SDHV-HORCU-A-C	
	SDHV-HRCU-A-CB	SDHV-HORCU-A-CB	

*A suffix of "-O" following any of these classifications indicates equipment not intended for use with field-installed duct systems.

Heat Rejection. Unitary air conditioner condensers may be air cooled, evaporatively cooled, or water cooled; the letters A, E, or W follow the Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute (AHRI) designation.

Heat Source/Sink. Unitary heat pump outdoor coils are designated as air or water source by an A or W, following AHRI practice. The same coils that act as a heat sink in cooling mode act as the heat source in heating mode.

Unit Exterior. The unit exterior should be decorative for in-space application, functional for equipment room and ducts, and weatherproofed for outdoors.

Placement. Unitary equipment can be mounted on floors, walls, ceilings, roofs, or a pad on the ground.

Indoor Air. Equipment with fans may have airflow arranged for vertical upflow or downflow, horizontal flow, 90° or 180° turns, or multizone. Indoor coils without fans are intended for forced-air furnaces or blower packages. Variable-volume blowers may be incorporated with some systems.

Location. Unitary equipment intended for indoor use may be placed in the conditioned space with plenums or furred-in ducts or concealed in closets, attics, crawlspaces, basements, garages, utility rooms, or equipment rooms. Wall-mounted equipment may be attached to or built into a wall or transom. Outdoor equipment may be mounted on roofs or concrete pads on the ground. Installations must conform to local codes.

Heat. Unitary systems may incorporate gas-fired, oil-fired, electric, hot-water coil, or steam coil heating sections. In unitary heat pumps, these heating sections supplement the heating capability.

Ventilation Air. Outdoor air dampers may be built into equipment to provide outdoor air for cooling or ventilation.

Refrigerant Flow. Unitary equipment can use either constant or variable refrigerant flow.

Desuperheaters. Desuperheaters may be applied to unitary air conditioners and heat pumps. These devices recover heat from the compressor discharge gas and use it to heat domestic hot water. The desuperheater usually consists of a pump, heat exchanger, and controls, and can produce about 1.5 mL/s of heated water per kilowatt of air conditioning (heating water from 15 to 54°C). Because desuperheaters improve cooling performance and reduce the degrading effect of cycling during heating, they are best applied where cooling requirements are high and where a significant number of heating hours occur above the building's balance point (Counts 1985). Although properly applied desuperheaters can improve cooling efficiency, they can also reduce space-heating capacity. This causes the unit to run longer, which reduces system cycling above the balance point.

Ductwork. Unitary equipment is usually designed with fan capability for ductwork, although some units may be designed to discharge directly into the conditioned space.

Accessories. For any unitary equipment, consult the manufacturer or their literature before installing any accessories or equipment not specifically approved by the manufacturer. These installations may not only void the warranty, but also could cause the unitary equipment to function improperly or create fire or explosion hazards.

Single-Package Equipment: Types and Installations

Figures 4 to 10 show various types and installations of single-package equipment. Figure 8 shows a typical installation of a split-system, air-cooled condensing unit with indoor coil (the most widely used unitary cooling system). Figures 9 and 10 show split-system condensing units with coils and blower-coil units. Figure 9 also shows ductless blower-coil units discharging air directly into the space. Ductless indoor units can be wall mounted, under-ceiling mounted, or ceiling cassette (see Figure 3).

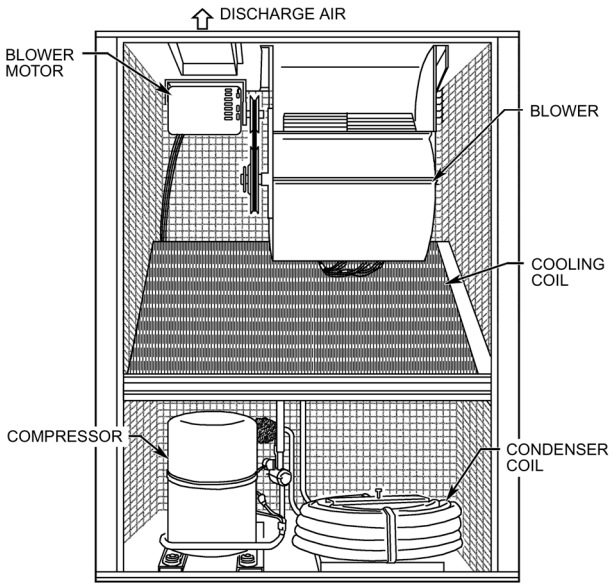


Fig. 4 Water-Cooled Single-Package Air Conditioner

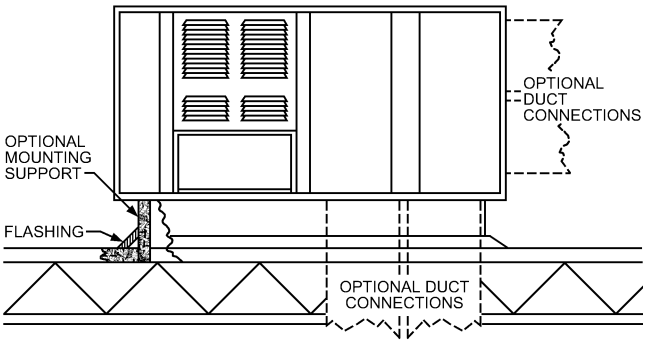


Fig. 5 Rooftop Installation of Air-Cooled Single-Package Unit

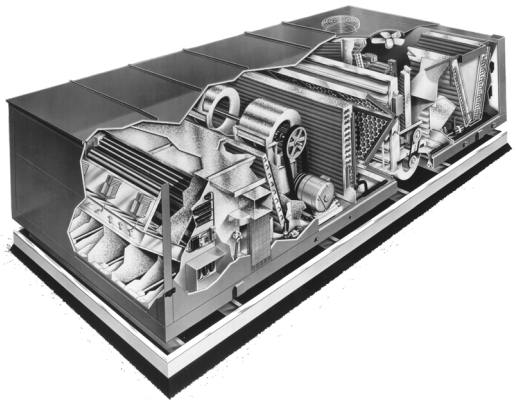


Fig. 6 Multistory Rooftop Installation of Single-Package Unit

Many special light commercial and commercial unitary installations include a single-package air conditioner for use with variable-air-volume systems, as shown in Figure 2. These units are often equipped with a factory-installed system for controlling air volume in response to supply duct pressure (such as dampers or variable-speed drives).

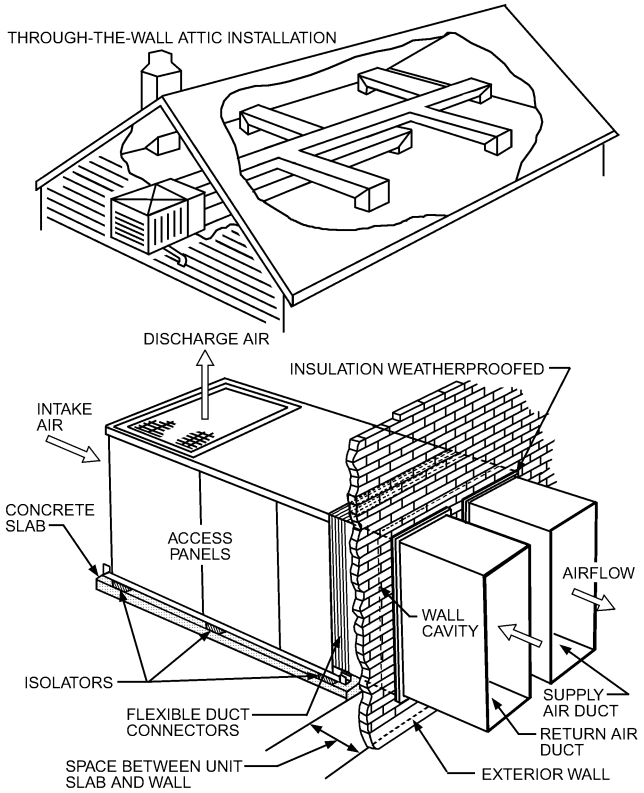


Fig. 7 Through-the-Wall Installation of Air-Cooled Single-Package Unit

Another example of a specialized unit is the **multizone unit**. The manufacturer usually provides all controls, including zone dampers. The air path in these units is designed so that supply air may flow through a hot deck containing a means of heating, or through a cold deck, which usually contains a direct-expansion evaporator coil. To make multizone units more efficient, a control is commonly provided that locks out cooling by refrigeration when the heating unit is in operation and vice versa. Another variation to improve efficiency is the three-deck multizone. This unit has a hot deck, a cold deck, and a neutral deck carrying return air. Hot and/or cold deck air mixes only with air in the neutral deck.

Combined Space-Conditioning/Water-Heating Systems

Unitary systems are available that provide both space conditioning and potable-water heating. These systems are typically heat pumps, but some are available for cooling only. One type of combined system includes a full-condensing water-heating heat exchanger integrated into the refrigerant circuit of the space-conditioning system. Full-condensing system heat exchangers are larger than desuperheaters; they are generally sized to take the full condensing output of the compressor. Thus, they have much greater water-heating capacity. They also have controls that allow them to heat water year-round, either independently or coincidentally with space heating or space cooling. In spring and fall, the system is typically operated only to heat water.

Another type of combined system incorporates a separate, ancillary **heat pump water heater (HPWH)**. The evaporator of this heater typically uses the return air (or liquid) stream of the space-conditioning system as a heat source. The HPWH thus cools the return stream during both space heating and cooling. In spring and fall, the space-conditioning blower (or pump) operates when water heating is needed.

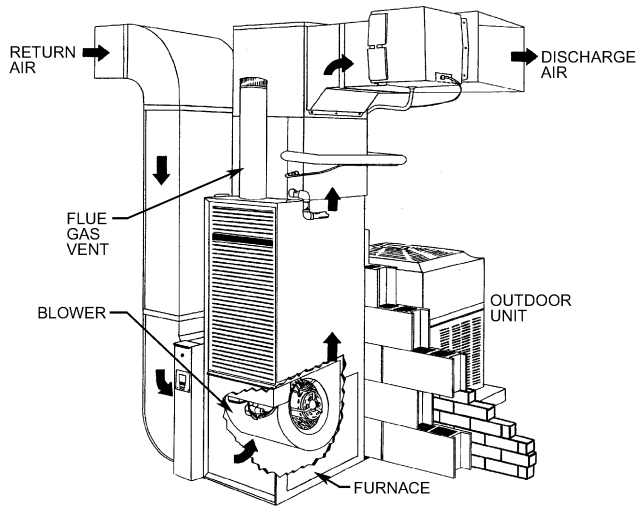


Fig. 8 Residential Installation of Split-System Air-Cooled Condensing Unit with Coil and Upflow Furnace

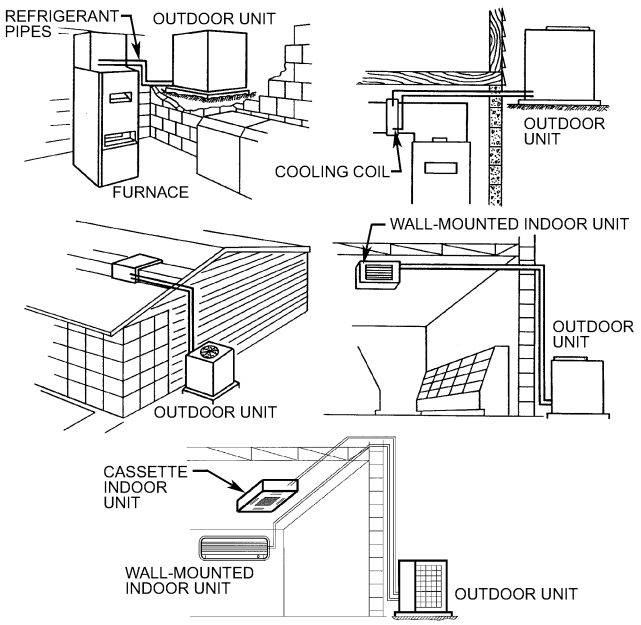


Fig. 9 Outdoor Installations of Split-System Air-Cooled Condensing Units with Coil and Upflow Furnace or with Indoor Blower-Coils

As with desuperheaters, simultaneous space and water heating reduces the output for space heating. This lower output is partially compensated for by reduced cycling of the space-heating system above the balance point.

Combined systems can provide end users with significant energy savings, and electric utilities with a significant reduction in demand. The overall performance of these systems is affected by the refrigerant charge and piping, water piping, and control logic and wiring. It is important, therefore, that the manufacturer's recommendations be closely followed. One special requirement is to locate water-containing sections in areas not normally subjected to freezing temperatures.

Engine-Driven Heat Pumps and Air Conditioners

Although the primary focus of this chapter is electrically powered unitary systems, other input power sources are available. See Chapter 7 for details.

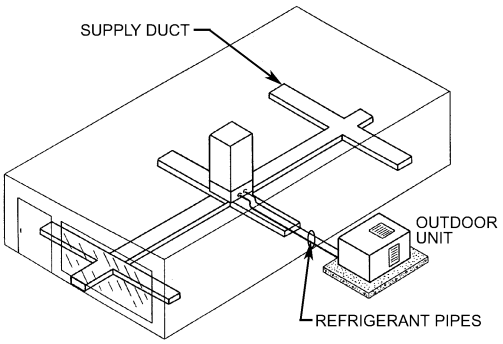


Fig. 10 Outdoor Installation of Split-System Air-Cooled Condensing Unit with Indoor Coil and Downflow Furnace

3. EQUIPMENT AND SYSTEM STANDARDS

Energy Conservation and Efficiency

In the United States, the Energy Policy and Conservation Act (Public Law 94-163) requires the Federal Trade Commission (FTC) to prescribe an energy label for many major appliances, including unitary air conditioners and heat pumps. The National Appliance Energy Conservation Act (NAECA) (Public Law 100-12) provides minimum efficiency standards for major appliances, including unitary air conditioners and heat pumps. On January 1, 2015, regional efficiency standards went into effect for residential central air conditioners and heat pumps. In addition to national minimum efficiency requirements for the ratings discussed in this section, some equipment in the southern and southwestern regions has higher minimum requirements. Also, split-system air conditioners in the southwestern region have minimum requirements for energy-efficiency ratio (EER). The states included in each region are shown in Figure 11. See 10 CFR Part 430 for details. On January 1, 2023, new standards went into effect (Table 3)

Table 3 Amended Energy Conservation Standards for Residential Central Air Conditioners and Heat Pumps, Effective January 1, 2023

	National		Southeast	Southwest	
Product Class	**COP**	**HSPF**	**COP**	**COP**	**EER**
Split-system air conditioners					
Certified cooling capacity <13 kW	4.1		4.4	4.4	12.2/10.2[a]
Certified cooling capacity ≥≤13 kW	4.1		4.2	4.2	11.7/10.2 [a]
Split-system heat pumps	4.4	8.8			
Single-package air conditioners[b]	4.1				11.0
Single-package heat pumps[b]	4.1	8.0			
Space-constrained air conditioners[b]	3.5				
Space-constrained heat pumps[b]	3.5	7.4			
Small-duct high-velocity systems[b]	3.5	7.2			

[a]The 10.2 EER amended energy conservation standard applies to split-system air conditioners with a seasonal energy efficiency ratio greater than or equal to 16.
[b]The energy conservation standards for single-package, small-duct high-velocity and space-constrained product classes remain unchanged from current levels.

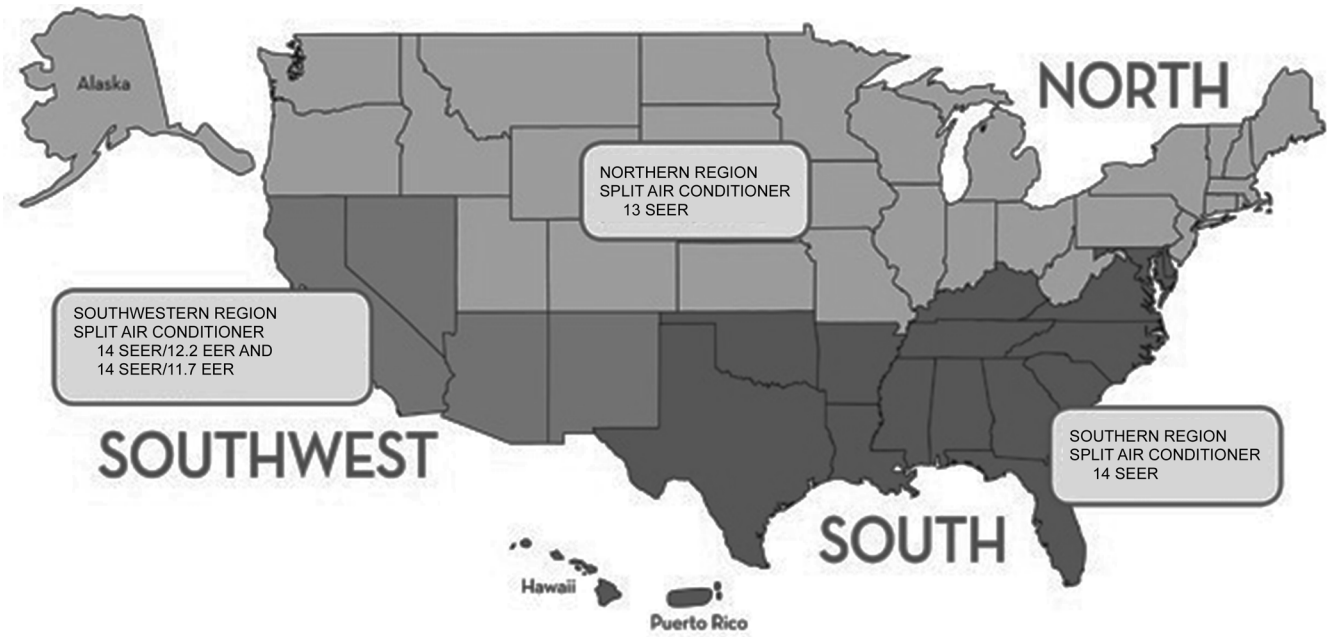


Fig. 11 Regional Appliance Efficiency Standards Map, Effective January 1, 2015

Schwartz (2011)

The U.S. Department of Energy's testing and rating procedure is documented in Appendix M to Subpart B of 10 CFR 430 [DOE (Annual)]. This testing procedure provides a seasonal measure of operating efficiency for residential unitary equipment. The **seasonal energy efficiency ratio (SEER)** is the ratio of total seasonal cooling output to total seasonal watt-hours of input energy. [SEER is not in SI units. To obtain coefficient of performance (COP), multiply SEER by 0.293.]This efficiency value is developed in the laboratory by conducting tests at various indoor and outdoor conditions, including a measure of performance under cyclic operation.

Seasonal heating mode efficiencies of heat pumps are similarly expressed as the ratio of total heating output to total seasonal input energy. This is expressed as a **heating seasonal performance factor (HSPF)**.(HSPF is not in SI units. To obtain COP, multiply HSPF by 0.293.) In the laboratory, HSPF is determined from test results at different conditions, including a measure of cyclic performance. The calculated HSPF depends not only on the measured equipment performance, but also on climatic conditions and heating load relative to the equipment capacity.

For HSPF rating purposes, the DOE divided the United States into six climatic regions and defined a range of maximum and minimum design loads, producing about 30 different HSPF ratings for a given piece of equipment. For comparative certified performance ratings, the DOE uses Region 4 (moderate northern climate) and minimum design load as the typical climatic region and building design load.

SEER, HSPF, and operating costs vary appreciably with equipment design and size and from manufacturer to manufacturer. SEER and HSPF values, size ranges, and unit operating costs for DOE-covered unitary air conditioners certified by AHRI are published semiannually in the AHRI *Unitary Large Equipment Directory of Certified Product Performance*.

In the United States, the Energy Policy Act of 1992 requires unitary equipment with cooling capacities from 19 to 70 kW to meet the minimum efficiency levels prescribed by ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1. The Department of Energy reviews each new edition of the standard and makes a determination within one year as to whether the new edition results in greater efficiencies than the previous edition, and then states have two years to adopt or exceed the new efficiency requirements.

AHRI Certification Programs

AHRI certification programs for unitary equipment include the following:

- Unitary air conditioners (water-, air-, and evaporatively cooled) under 19 kW
- Air-source unitary heat pumps under 19 kW
- Unitary large equipment at or above 19 kW

Information on specific programs is available at www.ahridirectory.org. Smaller equipment is rated according to AHRI *Standard* 210/240 and ASHRAE *Standard* 37. Large equipment is rated according to AHRI *Standards* 340/360 and 366. Sound ratings are discussed in AHRI *Standard* 270, and sound application in AHRI *Standard* 275.

Safety Standards and Installation Codes

Approval agencies list unitary air conditioners complying with a standard such as CSA *Standard* C22.2 No. 236/UL *Standard* 1995. Other UL standards may also apply. Evaluation of the product determines that its design complies with the construction requirements specified in the standard and that the equipment can be installed in accordance with the applicable requirements of the *National Electrical Code*®, ASHRAE *Standard* 15, and NFPA *Standards* 90A and 90B.

Tests confirm that the equipment and all components operate within their recognized ratings, including electrical, temperature, and pressure, when the equipment is energized at rated voltage and operated at specified environmental conditions. Stipulated abnormal conditions are also imposed under which the product must perform in a safe manner. The evaluation covers all operational features (e.g., electric space heating) that may be used in the product.

Products complying with the applicable requirements may bear the agency listing mark. An approval agency program includes auditing continued production at the manufacturer's factory.

4. AIR CONDITIONERS

Unitary air conditioners consist of factory-matched refrigerant circuit components that are applied in the field to fulfill the user's requirements. The manufacturer often incorporates a heating function compatible with the cooling system and a control system that requires minimal field wiring.

Products are available to meet the objectives of nearly any system. Many different heating sections (gas- or oil-fired, electric, or condenser reheat), air filters, and heat pumps, which are a specialized form of unitary product, are available. Such matched equipment, selected with compatible accessory items, requires little field design or field installation work.

Refrigerant Circuit Design

Chapters 23, 38, and 39 describe coil, compressor, and condenser designs, respectively. Chapters 1, 6, 7, and 12 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook— Refrigeration* cover refrigerant circuit piping selection, chemistry, cleanliness, and lubrication. Proper coil circuiting is essential for adequate oil return to the compressor. Crankcase heaters are usually incorporated to prevent refrigerant migration to the compressor crankcase during shutdown. Oil pressure switches and pumpdown or pumpout controls are used when additional protections for reliability are economical and/or required.

Safety Controls. High-pressure and high-temperature limiting devices, internal pressure bypasses, current-limiting devices, and devices that limit compressor torque prevent excessive mechanical and electrical stresses. Low-pressure or low-temperature cutout controllers may be used to protect against loss of charge, coil freeze-up, or loss of evaporator airflow. Because suction pressures drop momentarily during start-up, circuits with a low-pressure cutout controller may require a time-delay relay to bypass it momentarily to prevent nuisance tripping.

Flow Control Devices. Refrigerant flow is most commonly controlled either by a fixed metering device, such as a short-tube restrictor or capillary tube, or by thermostatic or electronic expansion valves. Capillaries and short-tube restrictors are simple, reliable, and economical, and can be sized for peak performance at rating conditions. The evaporator may be overfed at high condensing temperatures and underfed at low condensing temperatures because of changing pressure differential across the fixed metering device. Under these conditions, a less-than-optimum cooling capacity usually results. However, the degree of loss varies with condenser design, system volume, and total refrigerant charge. The amount of unit charge is critical, and a capillary-controlled evaporator must be matched to the specific condensing unit. Unlike units with thermostatic or electronic expansion valves, which are charged to a specified amount of subcooling, fixed-orifice control systems need to be charged to a specified superheat.

Properly sized thermostatic or electronic expansion valves provide constant superheat and more precise control over a range of operating conditions. Superheat is adjusted to ensure that only superheated gas returns to the compressor, usually with 4 to 8 K superheat at the compressor inlet at normal rating conditions. This superheat setting may be higher at a lower outdoor ambient temperature (cooling tower water temperature for water-cooled products) or indoor wet-bulb temperature. Compressor loading can be

limited with vapor-charged thermostatic expansion valves. Low-discharge-pressure (low ambient) operation decreases pressure drop across valves and capillaries so that full flow is not maintained. Decreased capacity, low coil temperatures, and freeze-up can result unless low ambient condensing-pressure control is provided.

Properly designed unitary equipment allows only a minimum amount of liquid refrigerant to return through the suction line to the compressor during non-steady-state operation. Normally, the heat absorbed in the evaporator vaporizes all of the refrigerant and adds a few degrees of superheat. However, any conditions that increase refrigerant flow beyond the evaporator's heat transfer capabilities can cause liquid carryover into the compressor return line. This increase may be caused by a poorly positioned thermal element of an expansion valve or by an increase in the condensing pressure of a capillary system, which may be caused by fouled condenser surfaces, excessive refrigerant charge, reduced flow of condenser air or water, or the higher temperature of the condenser cooling medium. Heat transfer at the evaporator may be reduced by dirty surfaces, low-temperature air entering the evaporator, or reduced airflow caused by a blockage in the air system.

Piping. Transient flow conditions are a special concern. During *off* periods, refrigerant migrates and condenses in the coldest part of the system. In an air conditioner in a cooled space, this area is typically the evaporator. When the compressor starts, liquid tends to return to the compressor in slugs. The severity of **slugging** is affected by temperature differences, *off* time, component positions, and traps formed in suction lines. Various methods such as suction-line accumulators, specially designed compressors, the refrigerant pumpdown cycle, nonbleed port thermostatic expansion valves, liquid-line solenoid valves, or limited refrigerant charge are used to avoid equipment problems associated with excessive liquid return. Chapter 1 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* has further information on refrigerant piping.

Strainers and filter-driers minimize the risk of foreign material restricting capillary tubes and expansion valves (e.g., small quantities of solder, flux, copper oxides, varnish). Overheated and oxidized oil may dissolve in warm refrigerant and deposit at lower temperatures in capillary tubes, expansion valves, and evaporators. Filter-driers are required by virtually all manufacturers when using hygroscopic lubricants such as polyol ester (POE) and polyvinyl ether (PVE), particularly for split-system units, to remove any moisture introduced during installation or servicing. Moisture contamination can cause oil breakdown, motor insulation failure, and freezing or other restrictions at the expansion device.

Capacity Control. Buildings with high internal heat loads require cooling even at low outdoor temperatures. The capacity of air-cooled condensers can be controlled by changing airflow or flooding tubes with refrigerant or using variable-speed compressors. Airflow can be changed by using dampers, adjusting fan speed, or stopping some of the fan motors in a multifan system.

In cool weather, air conditioners operate for short periods only. If the weather is also damp, high humidity levels with wide variances may occur. Properly designed capacity-controlled units operate for longer periods, which may improve humidity control and comfort. In any case, cooling equipment should not be grossly oversized.

Units with two or more separate refrigerant circuits allow independent operation of the individual systems, which reduces capacity while better matching changing load conditions. Larger, single-compressor systems may offer capacity reduction through unloading compressors, variable-speed or multispeed compressors, multiple compressors, or hot-gas bypass controls. At full-load operation, efficiency is unimpaired. However, reduced-capacity operation may increase or decrease system efficiency, depending on the capacity-reduction method used.

Variable-speed, multispeed, and staged multiple compressors can improve efficiency at part-load operation. Unloading can increase or decrease system performance, depending on the particular method used. Multispeed and variable-speed compressors, multiple compressors, and unloading generally produce higher comfort levels through lower cycling and better matching of capacity to load. Hot-gas bypass does not reduce capacity efficiently, although it generally provides a wider range of capacity reduction. Units with capacity-reduction compressors usually have capacity-controlled evaporators; otherwise evaporator coil temperatures may be too high to provide dehumidification. Capacity-controlled evaporators are usually split, with at least one of the expansion valves controlled by a solenoid valve. Evaporator capacity is reduced by closing the solenoid valve. Compressor capacity-reduction controls or a hot-gas bypass system then provides maximum dehumidification, while the evaporator coil temperature is maintained above freezing to avoid coil frosting. Chapter 2 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration* contains details on hot-gas bypass.

Air-Handling Systems

High airflow, low-static-pressure performance, simplicity, economics, and compact arrangement are characteristics that make propeller fans particularly suitable for nonducted air-cooled condensers. Small-diameter fans are direct-driven by four-, six-, or eight-pole motors. Low starting-torque requirements allow use of single-phase shaded pole and permanent split-capacitor (PSC) fan motors and simplify speed control for low-outdoor-temperature operation. Many larger units use multiple fans and three-phase motors. Larger-diameter fans are belt-driven at a lower speed to maintain low tip speeds and quiet operation.

Centrifugal blowers meet the higher static-pressure requirements of ducted air-cooled condensers, forced-air furnaces, and evaporators. Indoor airflow must be adjusted to suit duct systems and plenums while providing the required airflow to the coil. Some small blowers are direct driven with multispeed motors. In ductless indoor units, such as wall-mounted, under-ceiling-mounted, and ceiling cassette units, aluminum or fire-retardant plastic centrifugal fans are used. Large blowers are always belt driven and may have variable-pitch motor pulleys or a variable-frequency drive (VFD) for airflow adjustment. Vibration isolation reduces the amount of noise transmitted by bearings, motors, and blowers into cabinets. (See Chapter 21 for details of fan design and Chapters 19 and 20 for information on air distribution systems.)

PSC motors are widely applied to furnaces, air handlers, condensing units, and packaged equipment. They offer relatively low cost and high reliability, but efficiencies are relatively low. For applications with more stringent efficiency requirements, use electronically commutated motors (ECM). In addition to efficiency advantages, these motors can maintain a set airflow as static pressure varies. More recently, constant-torque motors (CTMs) have been used in indoor applications. These motors offer similar efficiencies as ECMs but at a lower cost. However, they maintain constant torque rather than constant airflow as static pressures change. This means that airflows vary as static pressure changes, but not as much as with a PSC motor. The fan motor selection process should consider the advantages and disadvantages of each motor technology, as well as the cost implications. Further information on motors used in HVAC applications may be found in Chapter 45.

Disposable fiberglass filters are popular because they are available in standard sizes at low cost. Cleanable filters can offer economic advantages, especially when cabinet dimensions are not compatible with common sizes. Charcoal filters can help remove volatile organic compounds (VOCs) or microparticles. Electronic or other high-efficiency air cleaners are used when a high degree of cleaning is desired. Larger equipment frequently is provided with automatic roll filters or high-efficiency bag filters. (See Chapter 29 for additional details about filters.)

Many units have a way to introduce outdoor air for economizer cooling and/or ventilation; rooftop units are particularly adaptable for receiving outdoor air. Air-to-air heat exchangers can be used to reduce energy losses from ventilation. Ductless units are provided with either a factory-mounted or a field-installed outdoor air kit. Some units have automatically controlled dampers to allow cooling by outdoor air, which increases system efficiency.

Electrical Design

Electrical controls for unitary equipment are selected and tested to perform their individual and interrelated functions properly and safely over the entire range of operating conditions. Internal line-break thermal protectors provide overcurrent protection for most single-phase motors, smaller three-phase motors, and hermetic compressor motors. These rapidly responding temperature sensors, embedded in motor windings, can provide precise locked rotor and running overload protection.

Branch-circuit, short-circuit, and ground-fault protection is commonly provided by fused disconnect switches. Time-delay fuses allow selection of fuse ratings closer to running currents and thus provide back-up motor overload protection, as well as short-circuit and ground-fault protection. Circuit breakers may be used in lieu of fuses where allowed by codes.

Some larger compressor motors have dual windings and contactors for step starting. A brief delay when energizing contactors reduces the magnitude of inrush current.

Using 24 V (NEC Class 2) control circuitry is common for room thermostats and interconnecting wiring between split systems. It offers advantages in temperature control, safety, and ease of installation. Electronic, communicating microprocessor thermostats and control systems are common. See Chapter 1 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* for further discussion.

Motor-speed controls are used to vary evaporator airflow of direct-drive fans, air-cooled condenser airflow for low-outdoor-temperature operation, and compressor speed to match load demand. Multitap motors and autotransformers provide one or more speed steps. Solid-state speed control circuits provide a continuously variable speed range. However, motor bearings, windings, overload protection, and motor suspension must be suitable for operation over the full speed range.

In addition to speed control, solid-state circuits can provide reliable temperature control, motor protection, and expansion valve refrigerant control. Complete temperature-control systems are frequently included with the unit. Features such as automatic night setback, economizer control sequence, and zone demand control of multizone equipment contribute to improved comfort and energy savings. Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* has additional information on control systems.

Mechanical Design

Cabinet height is important for rooftop and ceiling-suspended units. Size limitations of truck bodies, freight cars, doorways, elevators, and various rigging practices must be considered in large-unit design. In addition, structural strength of both the unit and the crate must be adequate for handling, warehouse stacking, shipping, and rigging.

Additionally, (1) cabinet insulation must prevent excessive sweating in high-humidity ambient conditions, (2) insulated surfaces exposed to moving air should withstand air erosion, (3) air leakage around panels and at cabinet joints should be minimized, (4) cabinet and coils should have a corrosion-resistant coating in highly corrosive environments, and (5) cabinet insulation must be adequate to reduce energy transfer losses from the circulating airstream.

Also, cooling-coil air velocities must be low enough to ensure that condensate is not blown off the coil. The drain pan must be sized to contain the condensate, must be protected from high-velocity air, and should be properly sloped to drain condensate to minimize standing water. Service access for installation and repair is required. Versatility of application, such as multiple fan discharge directions and the ability to install piping from either side of the unit, is another consideration. Weatherproofing requires careful attention and testing.

Accessories

Using standard cataloged accessories, the designer can often incorporate unitary products in special applications. Typical examples (see Figures 5, 7, 8, and 9) are plenum coil housings, return air filter grilles, and diffuser-return grilles for single-outlet units. Air duct kits offered for rooftop units (see Figure 5) allow concentric or side-by-side ducting, as well as horizontal or vertical connections. Mounting curbs are available to facilitate unit support and roof flashing. Accessories for ductless split units include wireless or wired thermostats, motorized air sweep flow louvers that automatically change airflow directions, and wind baffle kits for condensing-unit operation during high winds. Other accessories include high-static-pressure fan drives, controls for low-outdoor-temperature operation, coil guards for protection from hail and vandalism, and duct damper kits and economizers for control of outdoor air intakes and exhausts.

Heating

It is important to install cooling coils downstream of furnaces so that condensation does not form inside combustion and flue passages. Upstream cooling-coil placement is permissible when the furnace has been approved for this type of application and designed to prevent corrosion. Burners, pilot flames, and controls must be protected from the condensate.

Chapter 27 describes hot-water and steam coils used in unitary equipment, as well as the prevention of coil freezing from ventilation air in cold weather. Chapters 28, 31, and 33 discuss forced-air and oil- and gas-fired furnaces commonly used with, or included as part of, year-round equipment.

5. AIR-SOURCE HEAT PUMPS

Capacities of unitary air-source heat pumps generally range from about 5 to 100 kW (mini- and multisplit systems go smaller), although there is no specific limitation. This equipment is used in residential, commercial, and industrial applications. Multiunit and multisplit systems installations are particularly advantageous because they allow zoning, which allows heating or cooling in each zone on demand. Application factors unique to unitary heat pumps include the following:

- The unitary heat pump normally fulfills a dual function: heating and cooling; therefore, only a single piece of equipment is required for year-round comfort. Some regions, especially central and northern Europe and parts of North America, have little need for cooling. Some manufacturers offer heating-only heat pumps for these areas and for special applications.
- A single energy source can supply both heating and cooling requirements.
- Heat output can be as much as two to four times the purchased energy input.
- Vents and/or chimneys may be eliminated, thus reducing building costs.

In an air-source heat pump (Figure 12), the outdoor coil rejects heat to outdoor air in cooling mode and extracts heat from outdoor air in heating mode. Most residential applications consist of an indoor fan and coil unit, either vertical or horizontal, and an outdoor fan-coil unit. The compressor is usually in the outdoor unit. Electric heaters are commonly included in the indoor unit to provide heat during defrost cycles and during periods of high heating demand that cannot be satisfied by the heat pump alone.

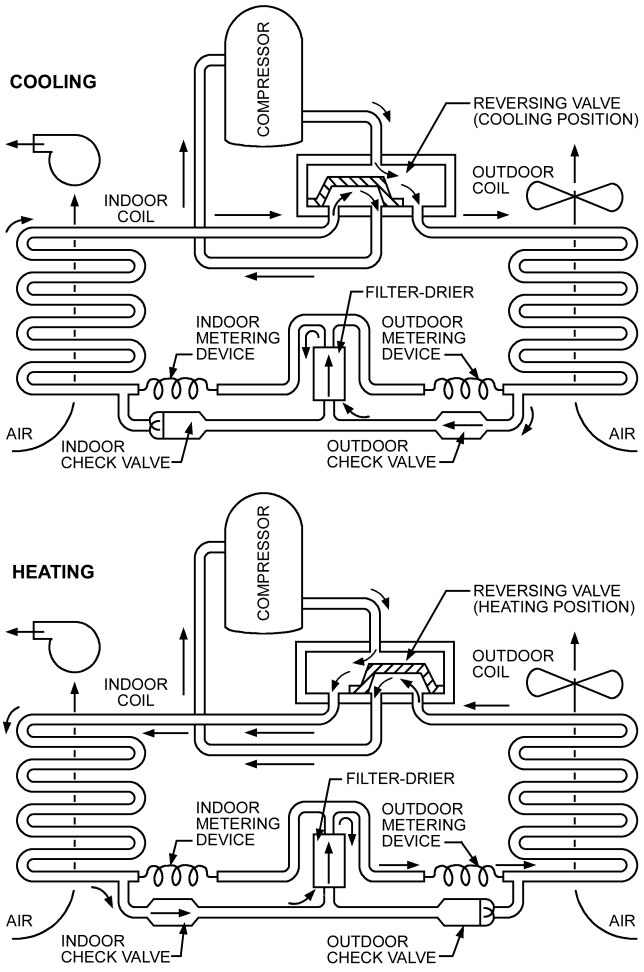


Fig. 12 Schematic Typical of Air-to-Air Heat Pump System

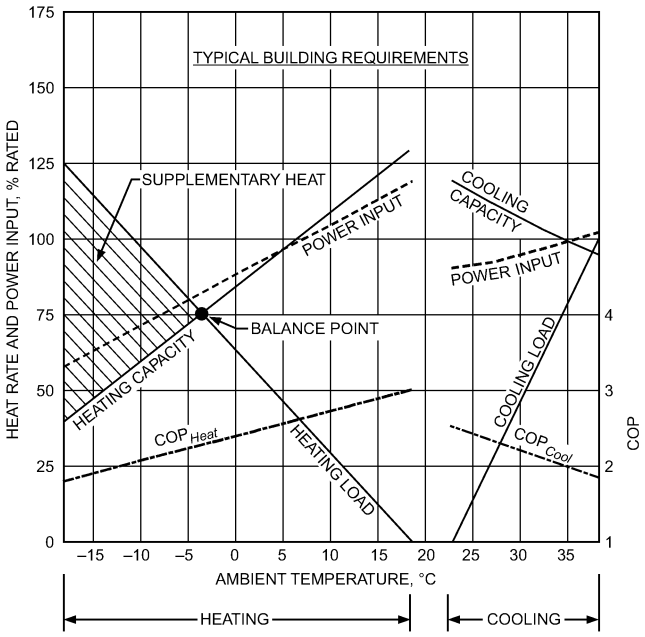


Fig. 13 Operating Characteristics of Single-Stage Unmodulated Heat Pump

Add-On Heat Pumps

An air-source heat pump can be added to new or existing gas- or oil-fired furnaces. This unit, typically called an add-on, dual-fuel, or hybrid heat pump, normally operates as a conventional heat pump. During extremely cold weather, the refrigerant circuit is turned off and the furnace provides the required space heating. These add-on heat pumps share the air distribution system with the warm-air furnace. The indoor coil may be either parallel to or in series with the furnace. However, the furnace should never be upstream of the indoor coil if both systems are operated together.

Special controls are available that prevent simultaneous operation of the heat pump and furnace in this configuration. This operation raises the refrigerant condensing temperature, which could cause compressor failure. In applications where the heat pump and furnace operate simultaneously, the furnace and heat pump indoor coil must be arranged in parallel, or the furnace combustion and flue passages must be designed to avoid condensation-induced corrosion during cooling operation. The furnace and heat pump often operate simultaneously during the heat pump's defrost mode to temper air temperature.

Selection

Figure 13 shows performance characteristics of a single-speed, air-source heat pump, along with heating and cooling loads for a typical building. Heat pump heating capacity decreases as ambient temperature decreases. This characteristic is opposite to the trend of the building load. The outdoor temperature at which heat pump capacity equals the building load is called the **balance point**. When outdoor temperature is below the balance point, supplemental heat (usually electric resistance) must be added to make up the difference, as shown by the shaded area. The coefficient of performance (COP) shown in Figure 13 is for the refrigerant circuit only and does not include supplemental heat effects below the balance point.

In selecting the proper size heat pump, the building cooling load is calculated using methodologies described in Chapters 17 and 18 of the 2021 ASHRAE *Handbook—Fundamentals*. The heating balance point may be lowered by improving the structure's thermal performance or by choosing a heat pump larger than the cooling load requires. Excessive oversizing of cooling capacity causes excessive cycling, which results in uncomfortable temperature and humidity levels during cooling.

Using variable-speed, multispeed, or multiple compressors and variable-speed fans can improve matching of both heating and cooling loads over an extended range. This equipment can reduce cycling losses and improve comfort levels. These types of heat pumps are of more benefit in cold climates, where heating capacities are generally much greater than cooling requirements.

Consult building codes before specifying indoor units that use plastic components where the proposed installation is in a return air plenum, because many codes require all materials exposed to airflow to be noncombustible or of limited combustibility.

Refrigerant Circuit and Components

In cold climates, heat pump yearly operating hours are often up to five times those of a cooling-only unit. In addition, heating extends over a greater range of operating conditions at higher-stress conditions, so the design must be thoroughly analyzed to ensure maximum reliability. Improved components and protective devices increase reliability, but the equipment designer must select components that are approved for the specific application.

For a reliable and efficient heat pump system, consider the following factors.

Outdoor Coil Circuitry. When the heat pump is used for heating, the outdoor coil operates as an evaporator. Refrigerant in the coil is less dense than when the coil operates as a condenser. To avoid excessive pressure drop during heating, circuitry usually compromises between optimum performance as an evaporator and as a condenser.

Defrost and Water Drainage. During colder outdoor temperatures, usually below 5 to 10°C, and high relative humidities (above 50%), the outdoor coil operates below the frost point of the outdoor air. Frost that builds up on the coil surface is usually removed by **reverse-cycle defrost**. In this method, refrigerant flow in the system is reversed, and hot gas from the compressor flows through the outdoor coil, melting the frost. A typical defrost takes 4 to 10 min. The outdoor fan is normally off during defrost. Because defrost is a transient process, capacity, power, and refrigerant pressures and temperatures in different parts of the system change throughout the defrost period (Miller 1989; O'Neal et al. 1989a).

Heat pump performance during defrost can be enhanced in several ways. Defrost times and water removal can be improved by ensuring that adequate refrigerant is routed to the lower refrigerant circuits in the outdoor coil. Properly sizing the defrost expansion device is critical for reducing defrost times and energy use (O'Neal et al. 1989b). If the expansion device is too small, suction pressure can be below atmospheric, defrost times become long, and energy use is high. If the expansion device is too large, the compressor can be flooded with liquid refrigerant. During conventional reverse-cycle defrost, there is a significant pressure spike at defrost termination. Starting the outdoor fan 30 to 45 s before defrost termination can minimize the spike (Anand et al. 1989). In cold climates, install the cabinet above grade to provide good drainage during defrost and to minimize snow and ice build-up around the cabinet. During prolonged periods of severe weather, it may be necessary to clear ice and snow from around the unit.

Several methods are used to determine the need to defrost. One common, simple, and reliable control method is to initiate defrost at predetermined time intervals (usually 90 min). Demand-type systems detect a need for defrosting by measuring changes in air pressure drop across the outdoor coil or changes in temperature difference between the outdoor coil and outdoor air. Microprocessors are used to control this function, as well as numerous other functions (Mueller and Bonne 1980). Demand defrost control is preferred because it requires less energy than other defrost methods.

Refrigerant Flow Controls. Separate refrigerant flow controls are usually used for indoor and outdoor coils. Because refrigerant flow reverses direction between heating and cooling modes, a check valve bypasses in the appropriate direction around each expansion device. Some expansion devices provide internal check valves. Capillaries, fixed orifices, thermostatic expansion valves, or electronically controlled expansion valves may be used; however, capillaries and fixed orifices require greater care to prevent excessive flooding of refrigerant into the compressor. A check valve is not needed when an orifice expansion device or biflow expansion valve is used. The reversing valve is the critical additional component required to make a heat pump air-conditioning system.

Refrigerant Charge Management. Extra care is required to control compressor flooding and refrigerant storage in the system during both heating and cooling. The mass flow of refrigerant during cooling is greater than during heating. Consequently, the amount of refrigerant stored may be greater in heating mode than in cooling, depending on the relative internal volumes of the indoor and outdoor coils. Usually, the internal volume of indoor coils ranges from 110 to 70% of the outdoor coil volume. The relative volumes can be adjusted so the coils not only transfer heat but also manage the charge.

When capillaries or fixed orifices are used, the refrigerant may be stored in an accumulator in the suction line or in receivers that can remove the refrigerant charge from circulation when compressor floodback is imminent. Thermostatic expansion valves reduce the flooding problem, but storage may be required in the condenser. Using accumulators and/or receivers is particularly important in split systems.

To maintain performance reliability, the amount of refrigerant in the system must be checked and adjusted in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations, particularly when charging a heat pump. Manufacturer recommendations for accumulator installation must be followed so that proper oil return is ensured.

Compressor Selection. Compressors are selected on the basis of performance, reliability, and probable applications of the unit. In good design practice, equipment manufacturers often consult with compressor manufacturers during both design and application phases of the unitary equipment to verify proper application of the compressor. Compressors in a heat pump operate over a wide range of suction and discharge pressures; thus, their design parameters (e.g., refrigerant discharge temperatures, pressure ratios, clearance volume, motor overload protection) require special consideration. In all operating conditions, protect compressors against loss of lubrication, liquid floodback, and high discharge temperatures.

System Control and Installation

Installation should follow the manufacturer's instructions. Because supply air from a heat pump is usually at a lower temperature (typically 32 to 38°C) than that from most heating systems, ducts and supply registers should control air velocity and throw to minimize perception of cool drafts.

Low-voltage heating/cooling thermostats control heat pump operation. Ductless split units are usually controlled by wireless thermostats. Models that switch automatically from heating to cooling operation and manual-selection models are available. Usually, heating is controlled in two stages. The first stage controls heat pump operation, and the second stage controls supplementary heat. When the heat pump cannot satisfy the first stage's call for heat, supplementary heat is added by the second-stage control. The amount of supplementary heat is often controlled by an outdoor thermostat that allows additional stages of heat to be turned on only when required by the colder outdoor temperature.

Microprocessor technology has led to night setback modes and intelligent recovery schemes for morning warm-up on heat pump systems (see Chapter 48 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*).

6. WATER-SOURCE HEAT PUMPS

A water-source heat pump (WSHP) is a single-package reverse-cycle heat pump that uses water as the heat source for heating and as the heat sink for cooling. The water supply may be a recirculating closed loop, a well, a lake, or a stream. Water for closed-loop heat pumps is usually circulated at 36 to 54 mL/s per kilowatt of cooling capacity. A **groundwater heat pump (GWHP)** can operate with considerably less water flow. The main components of a WSHP refrigeration system are a compressor, refrigerant-to-water heat exchanger, refrigerant-to-air heat exchanger, refrigerant expansion devices, and refrigerant-reversing valve. Figure 14 shows a schematic of a typical WSHP system.

Designs of packaged WSHPs range from horizontal units located primarily above the ceiling or on the roof, to vertical units usually located in basements or equipment rooms, and to console units located in the conditioned space. Figures 15 and 16 illustrate typical designs.

Systems

WSHPs are used in a variety of systems, such as

- Water-loop heat pump systems (Figure 17A)
- Groundwater heat pump systems (Figure 17B)
- Closed-loop surface-water heat pump systems (Figure 17C)

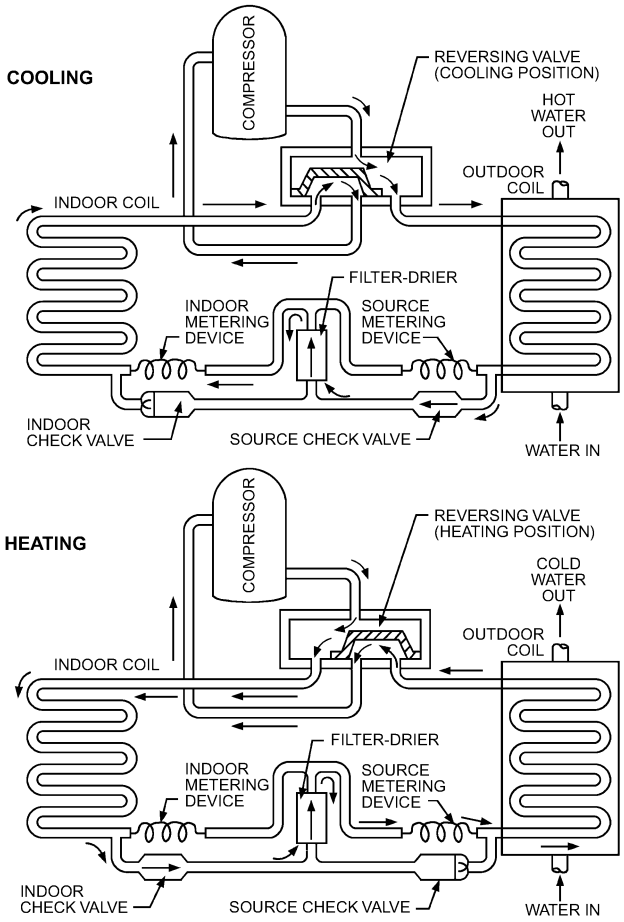


Fig. 14 Schematic of Typical Water-Source Heat Pump System

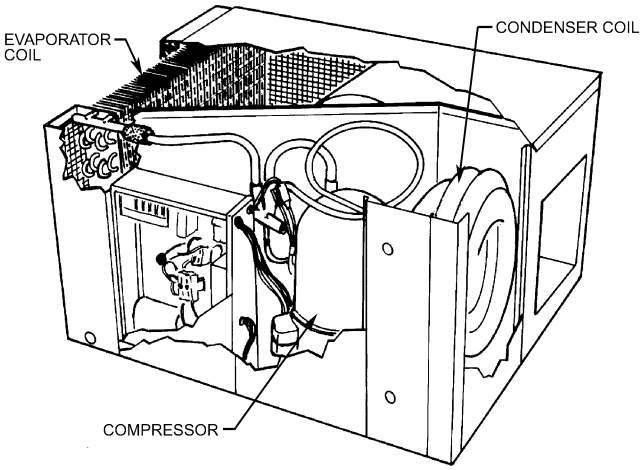


Fig. 15 Typical Horizontal Water-Source Heat Pump

- Surface-water heat pump systems (Figure 17D)
- Ground-coupled heat pump systems (Figure 17E)

A **water-loop heat pump (WLHP)** uses a circulating water loop as the heat source and heat sink. When loop water temperature exceeds a certain level during cooling, a cooling tower dissipates heat from the water loop into the atmosphere. When loop water temperature drops below a prescribed level during heating, heat is added to the circulating loop water, usually with a boiler. In multiple-unit installations, some heat pumps may operate in cooling mode while others operate in heating, and controls are needed to keep loop water temperature within the prescribed limits. Chapter 9 has more information on water-loop heat pumps.

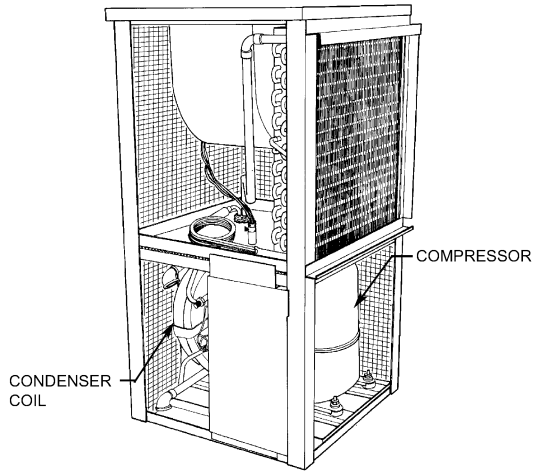


Fig. 16 Typical Vertical Water-Source Heat Pump

A **groundwater heat pump (GWHP)** passes groundwater from a nearby well through the heat pump's water-to-refrigerant heat exchanger, where it is warmed or cooled, depending on the operating mode. It is then discharged to a drain, stream, or lake, or is returned to the ground through a reinjection well.

Many state and local jurisdictions have ordinances about use and discharge of groundwater. Because aquifers, the water table, and groundwater availability vary from region to region, these regulations cover a wide spectrum.

A **surface-water heat pump (SWHP)** uses water from a nearby lake, stream, or canal. After passing through the heat pump heat exchanger, it is returned to the source or a drain several degrees warmer or cooler, depending on the operating mode of the heat pump. **Closed-loop** surface water heat pumps use a closed water or brine loop that includes pipes or tubing submerged in the surface water (river, lake, or large pond) that serves as the heat exchanger. The adequacy of the total thermal capacity of the body of water must be considered.

A **ground-coupled heat pump (GCHP), ground-source heat pump (GSHP),** or **geothermal heat pump (GHP)** system uses the earth as a heat source and sink. Usually, plastic piping is installed in either a shallow horizontal or deep vertical array to form the heat exchanger. The massive thermal capacity of the earth provides a temperature-stabilizing effect on the circulating loop water or brine. Installing this type of system requires detailed knowledge of the climate; site; soil temperature, moisture content, and thermal characteristics; and performance, design, and installation of water-to-earth heat exchangers. Additional information on GCHP systems is presented in Chapter 35 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Entering Water Temperatures. These various water sources provide a wide range of entering water temperatures to WSHPs. Entering water temperatures vary not only by water source, but also by climate and time of year. Because of the wide range of entering water or brine temperatures encountered, it is not feasible to design a universal packaged product that can handle the full range of possibilities effectively. Therefore, WSHPs are rated for performance at a number of standard rating conditions.

Performance Certification Programs

AHRI certifies water-to-air and brine-to-air heat pumps rated below 39.5 kW, based on ISO *Standard* 13256-1. For details, go to www.ahridirectory.org.

Equipment Design

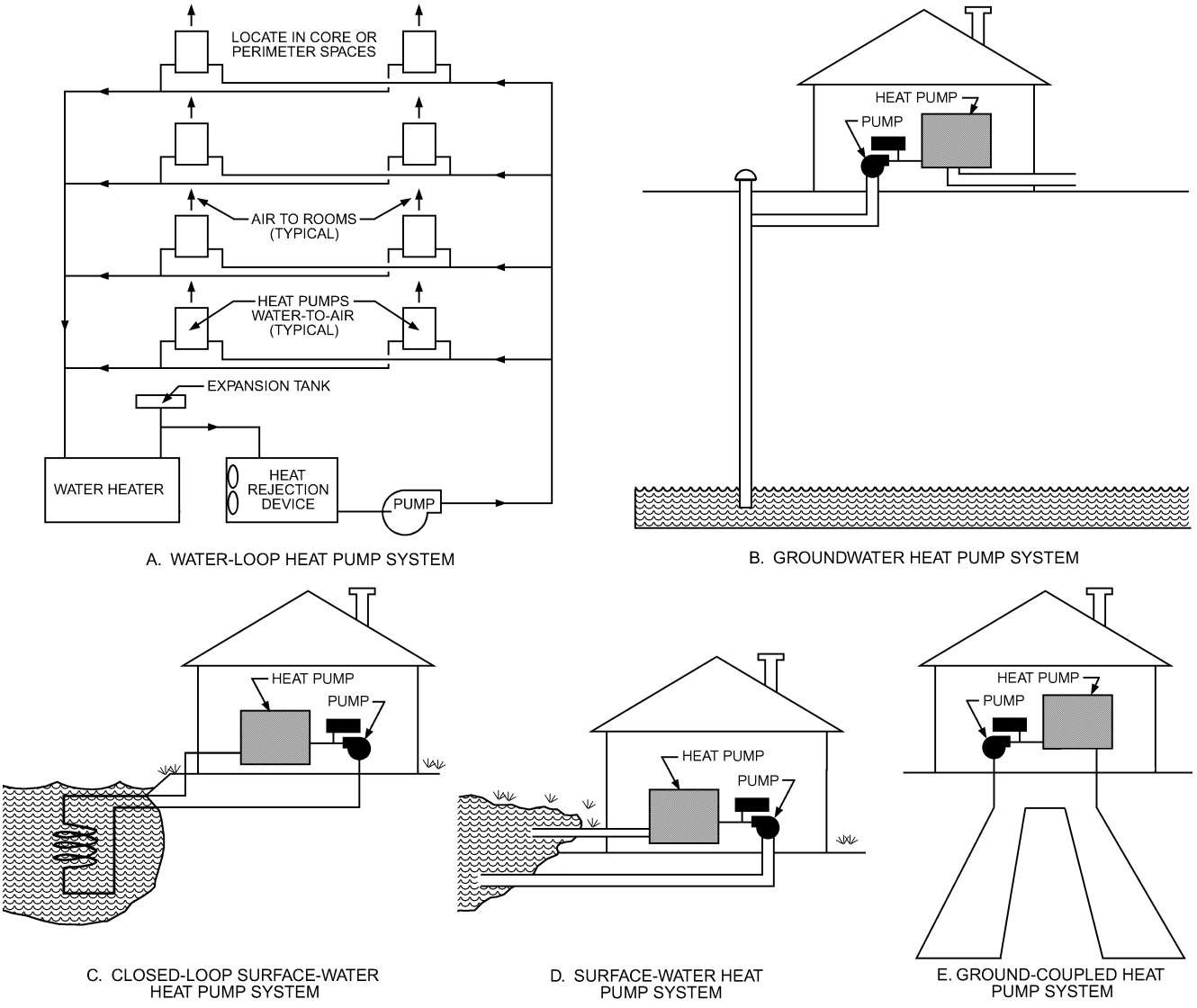
Water-source heat pumps are designed to match differing levels of entering water temperatures by optimizing the relative sizing of the indoor refrigerant-to-air heat exchanger and refrigerant-to-water heat exchangers and by matching expansion devices to refrigerant flow rates.

Compressors. WSHPs usually have single-speed compressors, although some high-efficiency models use multispeed compressors. Higher-capacity equipment may use multiple compressors. Compressors may be reciprocating, rotary, or scroll. Single-phase units are available at voltages of 115, 208, 230, and 265. All larger equipment is for three-phase power supplies with voltages of 208, 230, 460, or 575. Compressors usually have electromechanical protective devices.

Indoor Air System. Console WSHP models are designed for free delivery of conditioned air. Other models have ducting capability. Smaller WSHPs have multispeed, direct-drive centrifugal blower wheel fan systems. Large-capacity equipment has belt-drive systems. All units have provisions for fiberglass, metal, or plastic foam air filters.

Indoor Air Heat Exchanger. The indoor air heat exchanger of WSHP units is usually a conventional plate-fin coil of copper tubes and aluminum fins. Microchannel evaporators are also used in some products. The indoor air heat exchanger must be circuited so that it can function effectively as an evaporator with refrigerant flow in one direction and as a condenser when refrigerant flow is reversed.

Refrigerant-to-Water Heat Exchanger. The heat exchanger, which couples the heat pump to source/sink water, is tube-in-tube, tube-in-shell, or brazed-plate. It must function in either condensing or evaporating mode, so special attention is given to refrigerant-side circuitry. Heat exchanger construction is usually of copper and steel, and the source/sink water is exposed only to the copper portions. Cupronickel options to replace the copper are usually available for use with brackish or corrosive water. Brazed-plate heat exchangers are usually constructed of stainless steel, which reduces the need for special materials.



A. WATER-LOOP HEAT PUMP SYSTEM

B. GROUNDWATER HEAT PUMP SYSTEM

C. CLOSED-LOOP SURFACE-WATER HEAT PUMP SYSTEM

D. SURFACE-WATER HEAT PUMP SYSTEM

E. GROUND-COUPLED HEAT PUMP SYSTEM

Fig. 17 Water-Source Heat Pump Systems

Table 4 Space Requirements for Typical Packaged Water-Source Heat Pumps

Water-to-Air Heat Pump	Length × Width × Height, m	Mass, kg
5 kW vertical unit	0.6 × 0.6 × 0.9	80
10 kW vertical unit	0.8 × 0.8 × 1.2	110
10 kW horizontal unit	1.1 × 0.6 × 0.6	110
15 kW vertical unit	0.9 × 0.8 × 1.2	150
40 kW vertical unit	1.1 × 0.9 × 1.8	330
90 kW vertical unit	1.1 × 1.5 × 1.8	700

Note: See manufacturers' specification sheets for actual values.

Refrigerant Expansion Devices. These WSHPs operate over a narrow range of entering water temperatures and typically use simple capillaries as expansion devices. However, units may also use thermostatic expansion valves for improved performance over a broader range of inlet fluid temperatures.

Refrigerant-Reversing Valve. The refrigerant-reversing valves in WSHPs are identical to those used in air-source heat pumps.

Condensate Disposal. Condensate, which forms on the indoor coil when cooling, is collected and conveyed to a drain system.

Controls. Console WSHP units have built-in operating mode selector and thermostatic controls. Ducted units use low-voltage remote heat/cool thermostats.

Size. Typical space requirements and masses of WSHPs are presented in Table 3.

Special Features. Some WSHPs include the following:

Desuperheater. Uses discharge gas in a special water/refrigerant heat exchanger to heat water for a building.

Capacity modulation. May use multiple compressors, multispeed compressors, or hot-gas bypass.

Variable air volume (VAV). Reduces fan energy usage and requires some form of capacity modulation.

Automatic water valve. Closes off water flow through the unit when the compressor is off and allows variable water volume in the loop, which reduces pumping energy.

Outdoor air economizer. Cools directly with outdoor air to reduce or eliminate the need for mechanical refrigeration during mild or cold weather when outdoor humidity levels and air quality are appropriate.

Water-side economizer. Cools with loop water to reduce or eliminate the need for mechanical refrigeration during cold weather; requires a hydronic coil in the indoor air circuit that is valved into the circulating loop when loop temperatures are relatively low and cooling is required.

Electric heaters. Used in WLHP systems that do not have a boiler as a source for loop heating.

7. VARIABLE-REFRIGERANT-FLOW HEAT PUMPS

A variable-refrigerant-flow (VRF) system typically consists of a condensing section housing compressor(s) and condenser heat exchanger interconnected by a single set of refrigerant piping to multiple indoor direct-expansion (DX) evaporator fan-coil units. Thirty or more DX fan-coil units can be connected to a single condensing section, depending on system design, and with capacity ranging from 2 to 30 kW.

The DX fan-coils are constant air volume, but use variable refrigerant flow through an electronic expansion valve. The electronic expansion valve reacts to several temperature-sensing devices such as return air, inlet and outlet refrigerant temperatures, or suction pressure. The electronic expansion valve modulates to maintain the desired set point.

Application

VRF systems are most commonly air-to-air, but are also available in a water-source (water-to-refrigerant) configuration. They can be configured for simultaneous heating and cooling operation (some indoor fan-coil units operating in heating and some in cooling, depending on requirements of each building zone).

Indoor units are typically direct-expansion evaporators using individual electronic expansion devices and dedicated microprocessor controls for individual control. Each indoor unit can be controlled by an individual thermostat. The outdoor unit may connect several indoor evaporator units with capacities 130% or more than the outdoor condensing unit capacity.

Categories

VRF equipment is divided into three general categories: residential, light commercial, and applied. Residential equipment is single-phase unitary equipment with a cooling capacity of 19 kW or less. Light commercial equipment is generally three-phase, with cooling capacity greater than 19 kW, and is designed for small businesses and commercial properties. Applied equipment has cooling capacity higher than 40 kW and is designed for large commercial buildings.

Refrigerant Circuit and Components

VRF heat pump systems use a two-pipe (liquid and suction gas) system; simultaneous heat and cool systems use the same system, as well as a gas flow device that determines the proper routing of refrigerant gas to a particular indoor unit.

VRF systems use a sophisticated refrigerant circuit that monitors mass flow, oil flow, and balance to ensure optimum performance. This is accomplished in unison with variable-speed compressors and condenser fan motors. Both of these components adjust their frequency in reaction to changing mass flow conditions and refrigerant operating pressures and temperatures. A dedicated microprocessor continuously monitors and controls these key components to ensure proper refrigerant is delivered to each indoor unit in cooling or heating.

Heating and Defrost Operation

In heating mode, VRF systems typically must defrost like any mechanical heat pump, using reverse-cycle valves to temporarily operate the outdoor coil in cooling mode. Oil return and balance with the refrigerant circuit is managed by the microprocessor to ensure that any oil entrained in the low side of the system is brought back to the high side by increasing the refrigerant velocity using a high-frequency operation performed automatically based on hours of operation.

More information on VRF heat pumps can be found in Chapter 18, and information on performance-rating these systems can be found in AHRI *Standard* 1230-2010.

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CHAPTER 49

ROOM AIR CONDITIONERS AND PACKAGED TERMINAL AIR CONDITIONERS

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PACKAGED TERMINAL AIR CONDITIONERS 49.5
Sizes and Classifications 49.6
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1. ROOM AIR CONDITIONERS

ROOM air conditioners are encased assemblies designed primarily for mounting in a window or through a wall. They are designed to deliver cool or warm conditioned air to the room, either without ducts or with very short ducts (up to a maximum of about 1200 mm). Each unit includes a prime source of refrigeration and dehumidification and a means for circulating and filtering air; it may also include a means for ventilating and/or exhausting and heating.

The basic function of a room air conditioner is to provide comfort by cooling, dehumidifying, filtering or cleaning, and circulating the room air. It may also provide ventilation by introducing outdoor air into the room and/or exhausting room air to the outdoors. Room temperature may be controlled by an integral thermostat. The conditioner may provide heating by heat pump operation, electric resistance elements, or a combination of the two.

Figure 1 shows a typical room air conditioner in cooling mode. Warm room air passes over the cooling coil and transfers sensible and latent heat. The conditioned air is then recirculated in the room by a fan or blower.

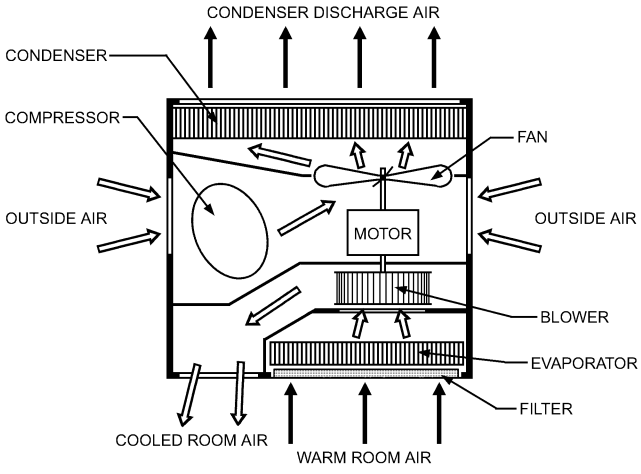

Fig. 1 Schematic View of Typical Room Air Conditioner

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 8.11, Unitary and Room Air Conditioners and Heat Pumps.

Heat from the warm room air vaporizes the cold (low-pressure) liquid refrigerant flowing through the evaporator. The vapor then carries the heat to the compressor, which compresses the vapor and increases its temperature above that of the outdoor air. In the condenser, the hot (high-pressure) refrigerant vapor liquefies, transferring the heat from the room air to outdoor air. Next, the high-pressure liquid refrigerant passes through a restrictor, which reduces its pressure and temperature. The cold (low-pressure) liquid refrigerant then enters the evaporator to repeat the refrigeration cycle.

1.1 SIZES AND CLASSIFICATIONS

Room air conditioners have line cords, which may be plugged into standard or special electric circuits. Most units in the United States are designed to operate at 115, 208, or 230 V; single-phase; 60 Hz power. Some units are rated at 265 V or 277 V, for which the chassis or chassis assembly must provide permanent electrical connection. The maximum amperage of 115 V units is generally 12 A, which is the maximum current permitted by NFPA *Standard* 70 (the *National Electrical Code*® [NEC]) for a single-outlet, 15 A circuit. Models designed for countries other than the United States are generally for 50 or 60 Hz systems, with typical design voltage ranges of 100 to 120 and 200 to 240 V, single-phase.

Popular 115 V models have capacities in the range of 1.5 to 2.3 kW, and are typically used in single-room applications. Larger-capacity 115 V units are in the 3.5 to 4.4 kW range. Capacities for 230, 208, or 230/208 V units range from 2.3 to 10.6 kW. These higher-voltage units are typically used in multiple-room installations.

Heat pump models are also available, usually for 208 or 230 V applications. These units are generally designed for reversed-refrigerant-cycle operation as the normal means of supplying heat but may incorporate electrical-resistance heat either to supplement heat pump capacity or to provide the total heating capacity when outdoor temperatures drop below a set value.

Another type of heating model incorporates electrical heating elements in regular cooling units so that heating is provided entirely by electrical resistance heat.

1.2 DESIGN

Room air conditioner design is usually based on one or more of the following criteria, any one of which automatically constrains the overall system design:

- Lowest initial cost
- Lowest operating cost (highest efficiency)

- Energy-efficiency ratio (EER) and combined energy efficiency ratio (CEER), or coefficient of performance (COP) and combined coefficient of performance (CCOP), as legislated by government
- Low sound level
- Chassis size
- Unusual chassis shape (e.g., minimal depth or height)
- Amperage limitation (e.g., 7.5 A, 12 A)
- Mass

Note that one of the integral characteristics of an air conditioner is its dehumidification capability. Although this is not usually a design or selection criterion for the unit, maintaining proper humidity levels while drawing less power is a desirable feature, especially in hot and humid areas (e.g., New Orleans).

The following combinations illustrate the effect of an initial design parameter on the various components:

Low Initial Cost. High airflow with minimum heat exchanger surface keeps the initial cost of a unit low. These units have a low-cost compressor, which is selected by analyzing various compressor and coil combinations and choosing the one that both achieves optimum performance and passes all tests required by Underwriters Laboratories (UL), the Association of Home Appliance Manufacturers (AHAM), and others. For example, a high-capacity compressor might be selected to meet the capacity requirement with a minimum heat transfer surface, but frost tests under maximum load may not be acceptable. These tests set the upper and lower limits of acceptability when low initial cost is the prime consideration.

Low Operating Cost. Large heat exchanger surfaces keep operating cost low. A compressor with a low compression ratio operates at low head pressure and high suction pressure, which results in a high COP.

Compressors

Room air conditioner compressors range in capacity from about 1.2 to 10 kW. Design data are available from compressor manufacturers at the following standard rating conditions:

Evaporating temperature	7.2°C
Compressor suction temperature	18.3°C
Condensing temperature	54.4°C
Liquid temperature	46.1°C
Ambient temperature	35.0°C

Compressor manufacturers offer complete performance curves at various evaporating and condensing temperatures to aid in selection for a given design specification. Single-speed compressors are the most common because of their low cost and simple control. Variable-speed inverter-driven compressors, although more expensive, are used for specialty applications where capacity control or seasonal efficiency is important.

Evaporator and Condenser Coils

These coils are generally tube-and-plate-fin, tube-and-louvered-fin, tube-and-spine-fin, microchannel-tube-and-flat-folded-fins, or microchannel-tube-and-louvered-folded-fin. Information on coil performance is available from suppliers, and original equipment manufacturers usually develop data for their own coils. See Chapter 23 for more information on air-cooling and dehumidifying coils. Design parameters to consider when selecting coils are

- Cooling rate per unit area of coil surface (W/m^2)
- Dry-bulb temperature and moisture content of entering air
- Air-side friction loss
- Internal refrigerant pressure drop
- Coil surface temperature
- Airflow
- Air velocity
- Sensible-to-latent heat factor of coil
- Dry/wet coil

Restrictor Application and Sizing

Three main types of restrictor devices are available to the designer: a **thermostatic expansion valve**, which maintains a constant amount of superheat at a point near the outlet of the evaporator; an **automatic expansion valve**, which maintains a constant suction pressure; and a **restrictor tube (capillary)**. The capillary is the most popular device for room air conditioner applications because of its low cost and high reliability, even though its refrigerant control over a wide range of ambient temperatures is not optimal. A recommended procedure for optimizing charge balance, condenser subcooling, and restrictor sizing is as follows:

1. Use an adjustable restrictor (e.g., a needle valve), so that tests may be run with a flooded evaporator coil and various refrigerant charges to determine the optimum point of system operation.
2. Reset the adjustable restrictor to the optimum setting, remove it from the unit, and measure flow pressure with a flow comparator similar to that described in ASHRAE *Standard* 28.
3. Install a restrictor tube with the same flow rate as the adjustable restrictor. Usually, restrictor tubes are selected on the basis of cost, with shorter tubes generally being less expensive.

Fan Motor and Air Impeller Selection

The two types of motors generally used on room air conditioners are the lower-efficiency, shaded-pole type, and more efficient, permanent split-capacitor type, which requires using a run capacitor. Air impellers are usually of two types: forward-curved blower wheel, or axial- or radial-flow fan blade. In general, blower wheels are used to move small to moderate amounts of air in high-resistance systems, and fan blades move moderate to high air volumes in low-resistance applications. Blower wheels and cross-flow fans also generate lower noise levels than fan blades.

The combination of fan motor and air impellers is so important to the overall design that the product designer should work closely with the manufacturers of both components. Performance curves are available for motors, blower wheels, and fans, but data are for ideal systems not usually found in practice because of physical size, motor speed, and component placement limitations.

Electronics

Microprocessors monitor and control numerous functions for room air conditioners. These microelectronic controls may offer digital displays and touch panels for programming desired temperature; on/off timing; modulated fan speeds; bypass capabilities; and sensing for humidity, temperature, and airflow control.

1.3 PERFORMANCE DATA

In the United States, an industry certification program under the sponsorship of the Association of Home Appliance Manufacturers (AHAM) covers most room air conditioners and certifies the cooling and heating capacities, COP, and electrical input (in amperes) of each for adherence to nameplate rating (see AHAM [2015] for product ratings). The following tests are specified by AHAM *Standard* RAC-1:

- Cooling capacity
- Heating capacity
- Maximum operating conditions (heating and cooling)
- Enclosure sweat
- Freeze-up
- Recirculated air quantity
- Moisture removal
- Ventilating air quantity and exhaust air quantity
- Electrical input (heating and cooling)

- Power factor
- Condensate disposal
- Application heating capacity
- Outdoor coil deicing

Efficiency

Efficiency is capacity in watts divided by input in watts. For room air conditioners, it may be called energy efficiency ratio (EER) or coefficient of performance (COP). To convert EER to COP, multiply EER × 0.2931.

$$CEER = \frac{750 \times AIC}{(750 \times P_I) + (5115 \times E_{TSO})} \quad (1)$$

where

The total time is 750 h in on mode and 5,115 h in standby and off mode.

AIC = adjusted indoor capacity, Btu/h, measured as per ASHRAE *Standard* 16
P_I = input power, W, measured as per ASHRAE *Standard* 16
E_{TSO} = standby and off mode annual energy consumption, kWh

$$E_{TSO} = [(P_{IA} \times S_{IA}) + (P_{OFF} \times S_{OFF})]K \quad (2)$$

where

E_{TSO} = standby and off mode annual energy consumption, kWh
P_{IA} = inactive mode power, W
P_{OFF} = off mode power, W
S_{IA} = inactive mode annual hours
S_{OFF} = off mode annual hours
K = 0.001 kWh/Wh conversion factor for watt-hours to kilowatt-hours

If the unit has both inactive and off mode, S_{IA} and S_{OFF} equal half of the total annual and off mode time (2,557.5 hours).

If the unit has only off mode, the off mode hours equal 5,115 hours and the inactive mode hours equal zero.

If the unit only has inactive mode, the inactive mode hours equal 5,115 hours and the active mode hours equal zero.

Sensible Heat Ratio

The ratio of sensible heat to total heat removal is a useful performance characteristic for evaluating units for specific conditions. A low ratio indicates more dehumidification capacity. Hot, humid areas like New Orleans and arid locales like Phoenix might best be served with units having lower and higher ratios, respectively. Although capacity and efficiency are certified data items with AHAM, dehumidification performance is not. Some manufacturers publish either the sensible heat ratio or the volume per hour of condensate removed as an aid for consumer selection of equipment.

Energy Conservation and Efficiency

The U.S. Department of Energy (DOE) issued increased minimum efficiency standards that became effective October 1, 2000 (*Federal Register* 1997), then raised these levels again effective June 1, 2014 (see Table 1). In the first ruling, four additional classes were created, two of which cover casement-type units. In the 2014 ruling, two product classes were split by capacity, and DOE added the effect of standby (*off*-mode) losses, renaming the efficiency metric as a **combined COP (CCOP)** and raising the values. The minimum standards range from 8.7 to 11.0 CEER (a CCOP of 2.55 to 3.22). For the most popular classes (cooling-only units with louvered sides ranging in capacity from less than 1800 to 8200 W), classes 1 to 5, the minimum standards range from a CCOP of 3.22 to 2.64. Table 1 also shows the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) and DOE's ENERGY STAR® requirements for room air conditioners. ENERGY STAR-qualified room air conditioners use at least 15% less energy than minimum-efficiency models. The EPA's ENERGY STAR website provides additional information on qualifying products (EPA 2016).

All state and local minimum efficiency standards in the United States are automatically superseded by federal standards. Many other countries have or are considering minimum efficiency standards, so such standards should be sought as part of the design process.

Whether estimating potential energy savings associated with appliance standards or estimating consumer operating costs, the annual hours H of operation of a room air conditioner are important. These figures have been compiled from various studies commissioned by DOE and AHAM for every major city and region in the United States. The national average is estimated at 750 h/year (AHAM 2010; Federal Register 2011a, 2011b, 2013) and maps have been developed by DOE and AHAM that can help estimate the usage for a specific location. The California Utilities/National Resources Defense Council (NRDC) also supported DOE's allocation of 750 h/year to active cooling as reasonable, given available data (California Utilities/NRDC 2010).

The estimated cost of operation is as follows:

$$C = RHW/1000$$

where

C = annual cost of operation, $/year
R = average cost, $/kWh
H = annual hours of operation
W = input, W

High-Efficiency Design

The COP can be affected by three design parameters. The first is **electrical efficiency**. Fan motor efficiency ranges from 25 to 78%; compressor motors range from 60 to 85%. The second parameter, **refrigerant cycle efficiency**, is increased by enhancing or enlarging the heat transfer surface to minimize the difference between the refrigerant saturation temperature and air temperature. This allows using a compressor with a smaller displacement and a high-efficiency motor. The third parameter is **air circuit efficiency**, which can be increased by minimizing pressure drop across the heat transfer surface, which reduces the load on the fan motor. The CCOP is further affected by power consumption during *off* mode or standby operation.

Higher COPs are one component of high-efficiency design. Additional energy savings can be achieved by properly sizing the unit, keeping infiltration and leakage losses to a minimum, increasing building insulation, reducing unnecessary internal loading, providing effective maintenance, and using thermostat setback.

1.4 SPECIAL FEATURES

Some room air conditioners are designed to minimize their extension beyond the building when mounted flush with the inside wall. Low-capacity models are usually smaller and less obtrusive than higher-capacity models. Units are often installed through the wall, where they do not interfere with windows. Exterior cabinet grilles may be designed to harmonize with the architecture of various buildings.

Most units have adjustable louvers or deflectors to distribute air into the room with satisfactory throw and without drafts. Louver design should eliminate recirculation of discharge air into the air inlet. Some units use motorized deflectors for continuously changing the air direction. Discharge air speeds range from 1.5 to 6 m/s, with low speeds preferred in rooms where people are at rest.

Most room air conditioners are designed to bring in outdoor air, exhaust room air, or both. Controls usually allow these features to function independently.

Table 1 Minimum Efficiency Standards for Room Air Conditioners[a]

Class	Reverse Cycle	Louvered Sides	Capacity, kW	Minimum Efficiency		
				COP[b] Oct. 1, 2000 to May 31, 2014	CCOP[b] As of June 1, 2014	ENERGY STAR Criteria Minimum COP[b]
1	No	Yes	<1.758	2.84	3.22	3.28
2	No	Yes	1.759 to 2.344	2.84	3.22	3.28
3	No	Yes	2.345 to 4.102	2.87	3.19	3.31
4	No	Yes	4.103 to 5.861	2.84	3.14	3.31
5a	No	Yes	5.862 to 8.205	2.49	2.76	2.87
5b	No	Yes	>8.206	2.49	2.64	2.87
6	No	No	<1.758	2.64	2.93	3.05
7	No	No	1.759 to 2.344	2.64	2.93	3.05
8a	No	No	2.345 to 3.223	2.49	2.81	2.87
8b	No	No	3.224 to 4.102	2.49	2.78	2.87
9	No	No	4.103 to 5.861	2.49	2.73	2.87
10	No	No	>5.862	2.49	2.76	2.87
11	Yes	Yes	<5.861	2.64	2.87	3.05
12	Yes	No	<4.103	2.49	2.73	2.87
13	Yes	Yes	>5.861	2.49	2.73	2.87
14	Yes	No	>4.103	2.35	2.55	2.70
15	Casement only	—	2.55	2.78	2.93	
16	Casement slider	—	2.78	3.05	3.19	

[a]For latest values, see CFR (annual). [b]Rounded to two decimal places.

Temperature is controlled by an adjustable built-in thermostat. The thermostat and unit controls may operate in one of the following modes:

- The unit is set to the cool position, and the thermostat setting is adjusted as needed. The circulation blower runs without interruption while the thermostat cycles the compressor on and off.
- The unit uses a two- or three-stage thermostat, which reduces blower speed as room temperature approaches the set temperature, cycles the compressor off as temperature drops further, and, if temperature drops still further, finally cycles the blower off. As room temperature rises, the sequence reverses. For units with variable-speed compressors, the thermostat may vary the fan speed proportionally as the room temperature nears the set point.
- The unit has, in addition to the preceding control sequence, an optional automatic fan mode in which both the blower and compressor are cycled simultaneously by the thermostat; this mode of operation requires proper thermostat sensitivity. One advantage of this arrangement is improved humidity control because moisture from the evaporator coil is not reevaporated into the room during the *off* cycle. Another advantage is lower operating cost because the blower motor does not operate during the *off* cycle. The effective COP may be increased an average of 10% by using the automatic fan mode (ORNL 1985).

Disadvantages of cycling fans with the compressor may be varying noise level because of fan cycling, and deterioration in room temperature control.

Room air conditioners are simple to operate. Usually, one control selects the operating mode, and a second controls the temperature. Additional knobs or levers operate louvers, deflectors, the ventilation system, exhaust dampers, and other special features. Controls are usually arranged on the front of the unit or concealed behind a readily accessible door, but may also be arranged on the top or sides of the unit, or on an infrared remote control.

Filters on room air conditioners remove airborne particulate matter to provide clean air to the room and keep cooling surfaces clean. Filters are made of expanded metal (with or without a viscous oil coating), glass fiber, or synthetic materials; they may be either disposable or reusable. A dirty filter reduces cooling and air circulation and frequently allows frost to accumulate on the cooling coil; therefore, filter location should allow easy monitoring, cleaning, and replacement.

Some units have louvers or grilles on the outdoor side to enhance appearance and protect the condenser fins. Sometimes, these louvers separate the airstreams to and from the condenser and reduce recirculation. When provided, side louvers on the outside of the unit are an essential part of the condenser air system because they improve air movement to the condenser. Take care not to obstruct air passages through these louvers.

Room air conditioners, especially those parts exposed to the weather, require a durable finish. Some manufacturers use a special grade of plastic for weather-exposed parts. If the parts are metal, good practice is to use phosphatized or zinc-coated steels with baked finishes and/or corrosion-resistant materials such as aluminum or stainless steel.

The sound level of a room air conditioner is an important factor, particularly when the unit is installed in a bedroom. A certain amount of sound can be expected because of air movement through the unit and compressor operation. However, a well-designed room air conditioner should be relatively quiet, and the sound emitted free of high-pitched and metallic noise. Usually, fan motors with two or more speeds are used to provide a slower fan speed for quieter operation. To avoid rattles and vibration in the building structure, units must be installed correctly (see the section on Installation and Service).

Excessive outdoor sound (condenser fan and compressor) can be irritating to neighbors. In the United States, many local and state outdoor noise ordinances limit outdoor sound levels.

1.5 SAFETY CODES AND STANDARDS

United States. The *National Electrical Code*® (NFPA *Standard* 70), ASHRAE *Standard* 15, and UL *Standard* 484 pertain to room air conditioners. Local regulations may differ with these standards, but the basic requirements are generally accepted throughout the United States.

Canada. CSA International developed the standard for Room Air Conditioners (CSA *Standard* C22.2 No. 117), which forms part of the *Canadian Electrical Code*.

International. Two useful documents that might assist the designer are (1) International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC)

Standard 60335-2-40 and (2) International Organization for Standardization (ISO) *Standard* 5151.

Product Standards

CSA *Standard* C22.2 No. 117 and UL *Standard* 484 are similar in content. In *Standard* 484, the construction section involves items such as the unit enclosure (including materials), ability to protect against contact with moving and uninsulated live parts, and means for installation or attachment. It also addresses the refrigeration system's ability to withstand operating pressures, system pressure relief in a fire, and refrigerant toxicity. Electrical considerations include supply connections, grounding, internal wiring and wiring methods, electrical spacing, motors and motor protection, uninsulated live parts, motor controllers and switching devices, air-heating components, and electrical insulating materials.

The performance section of the standard includes a rain test for determining the unit's ability to stand a beating rain without creating a shock hazard because of current leakage or insulation breakdown. Other tests include leakage current limitations based on UL *Standard* 101, measurement of input currents to establish nameplate ratings and size the supply circuit for the unit, temperature tests to determine whether components exceed their recognized temperature limits and/or electrical ratings (AHAM *Standard* RAC-1), and pressure tests to ensure that excessive pressure does not develop in the refrigeration system.

Abnormal conditions are also considered, such as failure of the condenser fan motor, which may lead to excessive pressure in the system, and possible ignition of combustibles in or adjacent to the unit on air heater burnout. A static load test is also conducted on window-mounted room air conditioners to determine whether the mounting hardware can adequately support the unit. As part of normal production control, tests are conducted for refrigerant leakage, dielectric strength, and grounding continuity.

Plastic materials are receiving increased consideration in the design and fabrication of room air conditioners because of their ease in forming, inherent resistance to corrosion, and decorative qualities. When considering using plastic, the engineer should consider the tensile, flexural, and impact strength of the material; its flammability characteristics; and (concerning degradation) its resistance to water absorption and exposure to ultraviolet light, ability to operate at elevated temperatures, and thermal aging characteristics. Considering product safety, some of these factors are less important because failure of the part will not cause a hazard. However, for some parts (e.g., bulkhead, base pan, and unit enclosure) that either support components or provide structural integrity, all these factors must be considered, and a complete analysis of the material must be made to determine whether it is suitable for the application.

1.6 INSTALLATION AND SERVICE

Installation procedures vary because units can be mounted in various ways. It is important to select the mounting for each installation that best satisfies the user and complies with applicable building codes. Common mounting methods include the following:

- **Indoor flush mounting.** Interior face of conditioner is approximately flush with inside wall.
- **Balance mounting.** Unit is approximately half inside and half outside window.
- **Outdoor flush mounting.** Outer face of unit is flush with or slightly beyond outside wall.
- **Special mounting.** Examples include casement windows, horizontal sliding windows, and office windows with swinging units (or swinging windows) to allow window washing, and transoms over doorways.
- **Through-the-wall mounts or sleeves.** This mounting is used for installing window-type chassis, complete units, or consoles in walls of apartment buildings, hotels, motels, and residences. Although very similar to window-mounted units, through-the-wall models do not have side louvers for condenser air; air comes from the outdoor end of the unit.

Room air conditioners have become more compact to minimize both loss of window light and projection inside and outside the structure. Several types of expandable mounts are now available for fast, dependable installation in single- and double-hung windows, as well as in horizontal sliding windows. Window air conditioners should fit in the opening without too much space around the sides; most units come with accordion-style flaps attached to the sides, used to fill the open space around the unit. Installation kits include all parts needed for structural mounting, such as gaskets, panels, and seals for weathertight assembly. Sealing the space around the unit (e.g., with caulk or foam seals) is important to prevent air from escaping and limit seeping of hot outdoor air into the conditioned space, and to achieve energy savings during operation.

Adequate wiring and proper breakers or fuses must be provided for the service outlet. Necessary information is usually given on instruction sheets or stamped on the air conditioner near the service cord or on the serial plate. It is important to follow the manufacturer's recommendation for size and type of breaker or fuse. All units are equipped by the manufacturer with grounding plug caps on the service cord. Receptacles with grounding contacts correctly designed to fit these plug caps should be used when units are installed.

Units rated 265 or 277 V must provide for permanent electrical connection with armored cable or conduit to the chassis or chassis assembly. Manufacturers usually provide an adequate cord and plug cap in the chassis assembly to facilitate installation and service.

One type of room air conditioner is the integral chassis design, with the outer cabinet fastened permanently to the chassis. Most electrical components can be serviced by partially dismantling the control area without removing the unit from the installation. Another type is the **slide-out chassis** design, which allows the outer cabinet to remain in place while the chassis is removed for service.

Effective condensate management should be considered during the installation of the air conditioner. Many window air conditioners have connection points for condensate drains. Follow plumbing and building code requirements for handling discharge of the condensate produced when the air conditioner is operating. Several methods could be used, such as a plastic line draining outdoors to an approved drain destination, to a floor drain, to a sump pit, or to a condensate pump that carries the condensate from the pan to the building drain or to the house main waste line. The drain line should be visually inspected during installation to check for improper piping or evidence of blockage, leaks, or overflow. Briefly testing the unit is helpful to confirm that the air conditioner is draining properly.

2. PACKAGED TERMINAL AIR CONDITIONERS

Title 10 §431.92 of the *Federal Register* and the Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute (AHRI) define a packaged terminal air conditioner (PTAC) as a wall sleeve and a separate unencased combination of heating and cooling assemblies intended for mounting through the wall. A PTAC includes refrigeration components, separable outdoor louvers, forced ventilation, and heating by hot water, steam, or electric resistance. PTAC units with indirect-fired gas heaters are also available from some manufacturers. A packaged terminal heat pump (PTHP) is a heat pump version of a PTAC that provides heat with a reverse-cycle operating mode. A PTHP should provide a supplementary heat source, which can be hot water, steam, electric resistance, or another source.

PTACs are designed primarily for commercial installations to provide the total heating and cooling functions for a room or zone

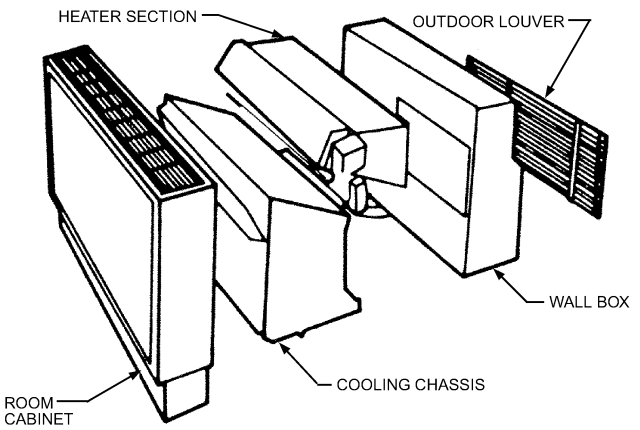

Fig. 2 Sectional Packaged Terminal Air Conditioner

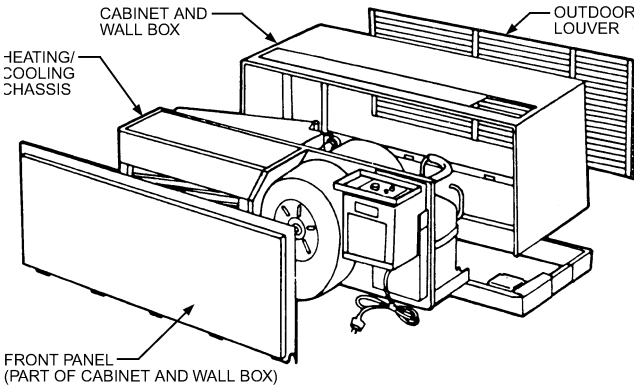

Fig. 3 Integrated Packaged Terminal Air Conditioner

and are specifically for through-the-wall installation. The units are mostly used in relatively small zones on the perimeter of buildings such as hotels and motels, apartments, hospitals, nursing homes, and office buildings. In larger buildings, they may be combined with nearly any system selected for environmental control of the building core.

PTACs and PTHPs are similar in design and construction. The most apparent difference is the addition of a refrigerant-reversing valve in the PTHP. Optional components that control the heating functions of the heat pump include an outdoor thermostat to signal the need for changes in heating operating modes, and, in more complex designs, frost sensors, defrost termination devices, and base pan heaters.

2.1 SIZES AND CLASSIFICATIONS

Packaged terminal air conditioners are available in a wide range of rated cooling capacities, typically 1.7 to 5.3 kW, with comparable levels of heating output. Units are available as sectional types or integrated types. A sectional-type unit (Figure 2) has a separate cooling chassis; an integrated-type unit (Figure 3) has an electric or a gas heating option added to the chassis. Hot-water or steam heating options are usually part of the cabinet or wall box. Both types include the following:

- Heating elements available in hot water, steam, electric, or gas heat
- Integral or remote temperature and operating controls
- Wall sleeve or box
- Removable (or separable) outdoor louvers
- Room cabinet
- Means for controlled forced ventilation
- Means for filtering air delivered to the room

PTAC assemblies are intended for use in free conditioned-air distribution, but a particular application may require minimal ductwork with a total external static resistance up to 25 Pa.

2.2 GENERAL DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

Packaged terminal air conditioners and packaged terminal heat pumps allow the HVAC designer to integrate the exposed outdoor louver or grille with the building design. Various grilles are available to blend with or accent most construction materials. Because the product becomes part of the building's facade, the architect must consider the product during the conception of the building. Wall sleeve installation is usually done by ironworkers, masons, or carpenters. All-electric units dominate the market.

All the energy of all-electric versions is dispersed through the building via electrical wiring, so the electric designer and electrical contractor play a major role. Final installation is reduced to sliding in the chassis and plugging the unit into an adjacent receptacle. For these all-electric units, the traditional HVAC contractor's work involving ducting, piping, and refrigeration systems is bypassed. This results in a low-cost installation and allows installation of the PTAC/PTHP chassis to be deferred until just before occupancy.

When comparing a gas-fired PTAC to a PTAC with electric resistance heat or a PTHP, evaluate both operating and installation costs. Generally, a gas-fired PTAC is more expensive to install but less expensive to operate in heating mode. A life-cycle cost comparison is recommended (see Chapter 38 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*).

One main advantage of the PTAC/PTHP concept is that it provides excellent zoning capability. Units can be shut down or operated in a holding condition during unoccupied periods. Present equipment efficiency-rating criteria are based on full-load operation, so an efficiency comparison to other approaches may suffer.

The designer must also consider that total capacity is the sum of the peak loads of each zone rather than the peak load of the building. Therefore, total cooling capacity of the zonal system will exceed that of a central system.

Because PTAC units are located in the conditioned space, both appearance and sound level of the equipment are important considerations. Sound attenuation in ducting is not available with the free-discharge PTAC units.

The designer must also consider the added infiltration and thermal leakage load resulting from perimeter wall penetrations. These losses are accounted for during the *on* cycle in equipment cooling ratings and PTHP heating ratings, but during the *off* cycle or with other forms of heating, they could be significant.

Most packaged terminal equipment is designed to fit into a wall aperture approximately 1100 mm wide and 400 mm high. Although unitary products can increase in size with increasing cooling capacity, PTAC/PTHP units, regardless of cooling capacity, are usually constrained to a few cabinet sizes. The exterior of the equipment must be essentially flush with the exterior wall to meet most building codes. In addition, cabinet structural requirements and the slide-in chassis reduce the available area for outdoor air inlet and relief to less than a total of 0.33 m^2. Manufacturers' specification sheets should be consulted for more accurate and detailed information.

Outdoor air recirculation must be minimized, and attention must be given to architectural appearance. These factors may increase air-side pressure drop.

2.3 DESIGN OF PTAC/PTHP COMPONENTS

Compressor. PTAC units are designed with single-speed compressors, either reciprocating or rotary. They normally operate on a single-phase power supply and are available in 208, 230, and 265 V versions. Smaller units are available in 115 V versions. Compressors usually have electromechanical protective devices, with some of the more advanced models using electronic protective systems.

Fan Motor(s). In some PTACs, a single, double-shafted direct-drive fan motor drives both the indoor and outdoor air-moving devices. This motor usually has two speeds, which affect the equipment sound level, throw of conditioned air, cooling capacity, efficiency, sensible-to-total heat capacity ratio, and condensate disposal.

Full-featured models have two fan motors: one moves indoor air and the other circulates outdoor air. Two motors provide greater flexibility in locating components, because indoor and outdoor fans are no longer constrained to the same rotating axis. They also allow different fan speeds for the indoor and outdoor systems. In this case, the outdoor fan motor is usually single-speed, and the indoor fan motor has two or more speeds. Also, the designer has a broader selection of air-moving devices and can provide the user with a wider range of sound level and conditioned air throw options. Efficiency can be maintained at lower indoor fan speeds. When heating (other than with a heat pump), the outdoor fan motor can be switched off automatically to reduce electrical energy consumption, decrease infiltration and heat transmission losses through the PTAC unit, and prevent ice from entrapping the fan blade.

Indoor Air Mover. Airflow quantity, air-side pressure rise, available fan motor speed, and sound level requirements of the indoor air system of a PTAC indicate that a centrifugal blower wheel provides reasonable indoor air performance. In some cases, proprietary mixed-flow blowers are used. Dual-fan motor units permit the use of multiple centrifugal blower wheels or a cross-flow blower to provide more even discharge of the conditioned air.

Indoor Air Circuit. PTACs have an air filter of fiberglass, metal, or plastic foam, which removes large particles from the circulating airstream. In addition to improving indoor air quality, this filter also reduces fouling of the indoor heat exchanger. The PTAC also provides mechanical means of introducing outdoor air into the indoor airstream. This air, which may or may not be filtered, controls infiltration and pressurization of the conditioned space.

Outdoor Air Mover. Outdoor air movers may be centrifugal blower wheels, mixed-flow blowers, or axial-flow fans.

Heat Exchangers. PTACs may use conventional plate-fin heat exchangers, which have either copper or aluminum tubes. The fins are usually aluminum, which may be coated for corrosion prevention purposes. Because PTACs are generally restricted in size, performance improvements based on increasing heat exchanger size are limited. Therefore, to improve performance or reduce costs, some manufacturers install heat exchangers with performance enhancements on the air side (lanced fins, spine fin, etc.) and/or the refrigerant side (internal finning or rifling).

Refrigerant Expansion Device. Most PTACs use a simple capillary as an expansion device. Off-rating-point performance is improved if expansion valves are used.

Condensate Disposal. Condensate forms on the indoor coil when cooling. Some PTACs require a drain to be installed to convey condensate to a disposal point. Other units spray condensate on the outdoor coil, where it is evaporated and dispersed to the outdoor ambient air. This evaporative cooling of the condenser enhances performance, but the potentially negative effects of fouling and corrosion of the outdoor heat exchanger must be considered. This problem is especially severe in a coastal installation where salt spray could mix with the condensate and, after repeated evaporation cycles, build a corrosive saltwater solution in the condensate sump.

A PTHP also produces condensate in heating mode. If the outdoor coil operates below freezing, the condensate forms frost, which melts during defrost. This water must be disposed of in some manner. If drains are used and the heat pump operates in below-freezing weather, the drain lines must be protected from freezing. Outdoor drains cannot be used in this case, unless they have drain heaters. Some PTHPs introduce condensate formed during heating onto the indoor coil, which humidifies the indoor air at the expense of heating capacity. Inadequate condensate disposal can lead to overflow at the unit and potential staining of the building facade.

Controls. PTAC units usually have a built-in manual mode selector (cool, heat, fan only, and off) and a manual fan-speed selector. A thermostat adjustment is provided with set points (usually subjective, such as *high*, *normal*, and *low*). Some units offer automatic changeover from heating to cooling. Most manufacturers offer low-voltage remote heat/cool thermostats. Some units have electronic controls that provide room temperature limiting, evaporator freeze-up protection, compressor lockout in the case of actual or impending compressor malfunction, and service diagnostic aids. Advanced master controls at a central location allow an operator to override the control settings registered by the occupant. These master controls may limit operation when certain room temperature limits are exceeded, adjust thermostat set points during unoccupied periods, and turn off certain units to limit peak electrical demand.

Some recent units include electrical interlocks for special operations of heat recovery subsystems in conjunction with controls of the PTAC/PTHP. Interlocks might be also used for preventing simultaneous operation of cooling and heating or to prevent operation of the unit when the sliding glass doors or windows are open. Sometimes electric interlocks are used in combination with sensors to prevent operation of the unit when the space is unoccupied.

Wall Sleeves. A wall sleeve is a required part of a PTAC unit. It becomes an integral part of the building structure and must be designed with sufficient strength to maintain its dimensional integrity after installation. It must withstand the potential corrosive effects of other building materials, such as mortar, and must endure long-term exposure to the outdoor elements.

Outdoor Grille. The outdoor grille or louvers must be compatible with the building's architecture. Most manufacturers provide options in this area. A properly designed grille prevents birds, vermin, and outdoor debris from entering; impedes entry of rain and snow; and provides adequate free area for the outdoor airstream to enter and exit with minimum recirculation.

Slide-In Components. The interface between the wall sleeve and slide-in component chassis allows the components to be easily inserted and later removed for service and/or replacement. In the event of serious malfunction, the slide-in component can be quickly replaced with a spare, and the repair can be made off the premises. An adequate seal at the interface is essential to exclude wind, rain, snow, and insects without jeopardizing the slide-in/slide-out feature.

Indoor Appearance. Because PTACs are located in the conditioned space, their indoor appearance must blend with the room's decor. Manufacturers provide a variety of indoor treatments, which include variations in shape, style, and materials.

2.4 HEAT PUMP OPERATION

Basic PTHP units can operate in heat pump mode until outdoor temperature is just above the point at which the outdoor heat exchanger would frost. At that point, heat pump mode is locked out, and other forms of heating are required. Some units include two-stage indoor thermostats and automatically switch from heat pump mode to an alternative heat source if space temperature drops too far below the first-stage set point. Some PTHPs use control schemes that extend heat pump operation to lower temperatures. One approach

allows heat pump operation down to outdoor temperatures just above freezing. If the outdoor coil frosts, it is defrosted by shutting down the compressor and allowing the outdoor fan to continue circulating outdoor air over the coil. Another approach allows heat pump operation to even lower outdoor temperatures by using a reverse-cycle defrost sequence. In those cases, the heat pump mode is usually locked out for outdoor temperatures below –12°C.

2.5 PERFORMANCE AND SAFETY TESTING

PTACs and PTHPs may be rated in accordance with AHRI *Standard* 310/380, which is equivalent to CSA International *Standard* C744.

AHRI issues a *Directory of Certified Products Performance* semiannually that lists cooling capacity, efficiency, and heating capacity for each participating manufacturer's PTAC models. The listings of PTHP models also include the heating COP.

Cooling and heating capacities, as listed in the AHRI directory, must be established in accordance with ASHRAE *Standard* 37 for unitary equipment, or *Standard* 16 for room air conditioners and PTACs. All standard heating ratings should be established in accordance with ASHRAE *Standard* 58.

Additionally, PTAC units should be constructed in accordance with ASHRAE *Standard* 15 and should comply with the safety requirements of UL *Standard* 484.

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CHAPTER 50

THERMAL STORAGE

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THERMAL storage systems remove heat from or add heat to a storage medium for use at another time. Thermal energy storage (TES) for HVAC and/or domestic water-heating applications can involve various temperatures associated with heating or cooling. High-temperature storage is typically associated with solar energy or high-temperature heating, and cool storage with air-conditioning, refrigeration, or cryogenic-temperature processes. Energy may be charged, stored, and discharged daily, weekly, annually, or in seasonal or rapid batch process cycles. Fast-acting and/or grid-interactive energy storage systems can provide balancing services and other critical needs of the electric grid, such as frequency control and renewable energy integration. These grid-interactive systems dynamically couple consumer energy usage to the grid's real-time needs. Historically, thermal storage has been used for comfort and process heating and cooling applications as a way to reduce the total utility bill and/or size of heating and cooling equipment. Dorgan and Elleson (1993) cover cool storage issues and design parameters in detail.

A properly designed and installed thermal storage system can

- Shift loads from peak to nonpeak times
- Reduce operating or initial costs
- Reduce size of electric service and cooling or heating equipment
- Increase operating flexibility
- Provide back-up capacity
- Extend the capacity of an existing system
- Provide regulation services for the electric grid (frequency control)
- Help integrate greater amounts of intermittent renewable energy (e.g., wind, solar) into the electric grid

Benefits are discussed further in the Benefits of Thermal Storage section.

Thermal storage may be a particularly attractive approach to meeting heating or cooling loads if one or more of the following conditions apply:

- Loads are of short duration.
- Loads occur infrequently.
- Loads are cyclical.
- Loads are not coincident with energy source availability.
- Energy costs are time-dependent (e.g., time-of-use energy rates).
- Charges for peak power demand are high.
- Utility rebates, tax credits, or other economic incentives are provided for using load-shifting equipment.
- Energy supply is limited, thus limiting or preventing the use of full-size nonstorage systems.
- Facility expansion is planned, and the existing heating or cooling equipment is insufficient to meet the new peak load but has spare nonpeak capacity.
- A mission-critical operation requires uninterrupted heating and/or cooling.

The preparation of this chapter is assigned to TC 6.9, Thermal Storage.

Terminology

Charging. Storing cooling capacity by removing heat from a cool storage device, or storing heating capacity by adding heat to a heat storage device.

Chiller priority. Control strategy for partial storage systems that uses the chiller to directly meet as much of the load as possible, normally by operating at design capacity most of the time. Thermal storage is used to supplement chiller operation only when the load exceeds the chiller capacity.

Cool storage. As used in this chapter, storage of cooling capacity in a storage medium at temperatures below the nominal temperature of the space or process.

Demand limiting. A partial storage operating strategy that limits capacity of HVAC equipment during peak demand periods. Equipment capacity may be limited based on its cooling capacity, its electric demand, or facility demand.

Design load profile. Calculated or measured hour-by-hour cooling loads over a complete cooling cycle that are considered to be the maximum total cooling load that must be met by mechanical means and/or capacity from a cool thermal storage system, provided in a graphical or tabular format.

Design operating profile. Equipment operation calculated or measured hour-by-hour, including mechanical refrigeration equipment, the thermal storage system's charge or discharge rate, and temperatures over the entire cooling system operating period.

Discharging. Using stored cooling capacity by adding thermal energy to a cool storage device or removing thermal energy from a heat storage device.

Encapsulated storage. A latent storage technology that consists of plastic containers of water or other phase-change material that are alternately frozen and melted by the influence of glycol or other secondary coolant medium in which they are immersed.

Full storage. A cool storage sizing strategy that meets the entire cooling load during a predefined on-peak demand period with discharge from the thermal storage system.

Fully charged condition. State of a cool thermal storage system at which, according to design, no more heat is to be removed from the storage device. This state is reached when the control system stops the charge cycle as part of its normal control sequence when the temperature of media leaving the storage system is equal to that entering the storage system.

Fully discharged condition. State of a cool thermal storage system at which no more usable cooling capacity can be delivered from the storage device. This state is reached when the control system stops the discharge cycle as part of its normal control sequence when the discharge temperature of media from the storage system exceeds a predefined temperature.

Grid-interactive electric thermal storage (GETS). An energy storage system that provides electric system grid operators (utilities, independent system operators [ISOs], regional transmission organizations [RTOs], etc.) with variable control of a building's space- and water-heating end uses to help real-time balancing of energy supply

and demand on the electric grid while providing low-cost space and water heat for consumers. GETS system components typically include an electric resistance heating element, a storage medium such as water or ceramic brick, bidirectional communications between the utility and customer, and a solid-state controller able to cycle the electric resistance elements in very small, discrete steps.

Heat storage. As used in this chapter, storage of thermal energy at temperatures above the nominal temperature of the space or process.

Ice harvester. Machine that cyclically forms a layer of ice on a smooth cooling surface, using refrigerant inside the heat exchanger, then delivers it to a storage container by heating the surface of the cooling plate, normally by reversing the refrigeration process and delivering hot gases inside the heat exchanger.

Ice-on-coil (ice-on-pipe). Ice storage technology that forms and stores ice on the outside of tubes or pipes submerged in an insulated water tank.

Ice-on-coil, external melt. Ice storage technology in which tubes or pipes (coil) are immersed in water and ice is formed on the outside of the tubes or pipes by circulating colder secondary medium or refrigerant inside the tubing or pipes, and is melted externally by circulating unfrozen water outside the tubes or pipes to the load.

Ice-on-coil, internal melt. Ice storage technology in which tubes or pipes (coil) are immersed in water and ice is formed on the outside of the tubes or pipes by circulating colder secondary medium or refrigerant inside the tubing or pipes, and is melted internally by circulating the same secondary coolant or refrigerant to the load.

Latent energy storage (latent heat storage). A thermal storage technology in which energy is stored within a medium, normally associated with a phase change (usually between solid and liquid states), for use in cooling or heating the secondary liquid being circulated through the system.

Load leveling. A partial storage sizing strategy that minimizes storage equipment size and storage capacity. The system operates with refrigeration equipment running at its most efficient capacity for 24 h to meet the normal cooling load profile and, when load is less than the chiller output, excess cooling is stored. When load exceeds chiller capacity, the additional cooling requirement is obtained from the thermal storage.

Load profile. Compilation of instantaneous thermal loads over a period of time, normally 24 h.

Mass storage. Storage of energy, in the form of sensible heat, in building materials, interior equipment, and furnishings.

Maximum usable cooling supply temperature. Maximum fluid supply temperature at which the cooling load can be met. This is generally determined by the requirements of the air-side distribution system or the process.

Maximum usable discharge temperature. Highest temperature at which beneficial cooling can be obtained from the thermal storage device.

Nominal chiller capacity. (1) Chiller capacity at standard Air-Conditioning and Refrigeration Institute (ARI) rating conditions. (2) Chiller capacity at a given operating condition selected for the purpose of quick chiller sizing selections.

Partial storage. A cool storage sizing strategy in which only a portion of the on-peak cooling load is met from thermal storage, with the rest being met by operating the chilling equipment.

Peak demand period. Period of time when electrical grid demands are high, resulting in higher power cost and often added demand charges by the supplying utility.

Phase-change material (PCM). A substance that undergoes a change of state, normally from solid to liquid or liquid to solid, while absorbing or rejecting thermal energy at a constant temperature.

Pulldown load. Unmet cooling or heating load that accumulates during a period when a cooling or heating system has not operated, or operated in a thermostat setback mode, and which must be met on system start-up before comfort conditions can be achieved. Maximum pulldown load generally occurs on a Monday morning or following an extended shutdown.

Renewable power generation. Renewable energy comes from sources that naturally replenish themselves over short periods of time (e.g., water flow, sunlight, wind, tides, waves, geothermal heat). Renewable power generation technologies convert this naturally occurring energy to electricity. These renewable energy sources have varying time constants, cycles, and energy densities. Some resources, such as wind and solar, produce electricity intermittently proportional to instantaneous wind speed and moments of sunlight. Renewable power generation is considered nonpolluting by nature.

Sensible energy storage (sensible heat storage). A heating or cooling thermal storage technology in which all energy stored is in the form of a measurable temperature difference between the hot or chilled water circulating through the system and the storage medium.

Storage cycle. A period in which a complete charge and discharge of a thermal storage device has occurred, beginning and ending at the same state.

Storage inventory. Amount of usable heating or cooling capacity remaining in a thermal storage device.

Storage priority. A control strategy that uses stored cooling to meet as much of the load as possible. Chillers operate only if the load exceeds the storage system's available cooling capacity.

Stratified chilled-water storage. A method of sensible cool thermal energy storage that achieves and maintains an acceptable separation between warm (discharged) and cool (charged) water by forming a thermocline by density differences alone, and not by mechanical separation.

Thermal storage capacity. A value indicating the maximum amount of cooling (or heating) that can be achieved by the stored medium in the thermal storage device and delivered to the load.

- **Discharge capacity.** The maximum rate at which cooling can be supplied from a cool storage device.
- **Nominal storage capacity.** A theoretical capacity of the thermal storage device. In many cases, this may be greater than the usable storage capacity. This measure should not be used to compare usable capacities of alternative storage systems.
- **System capacity.** Maximum amount of cooling that can be supplied by the entire cooling system, which may include chillers and thermal storage.
- **Usable storage capacity.** Total amount of beneficial cooling able to be discharged from a thermal storage device. (This may be less than the nominal storage capacity because the distribution header piping may not allow discharging the entire cooling capacity of the thermal storage device.)

Thermal storage device. A container plus all its contents used for storing heating or cooling energy. The heat transfer fluid and accessories, such as heat exchangers, agitators, circulating pumps, flow-switching devices, valves, and baffles that are integral with the container, are considered a part of the thermal storage device.

Thermocline. Thermal layer of water in a chilled-water thermal storage tank, separating warmer water at the top and cooler water at the bottom. The depth of this layer depends on the effectiveness and efficiency of the upper and lower diffusers, which are designed to supply and discharge water with minimal mixing. The typical thermocline is 460 to 600 mm, and rises and falls when charging and discharging the storage tank.

Total cooling load. Integrated thermal load that must be met by the cooling plant over a given period of time.

Unitary thermal storage system (UTSS). A packaged assembly including a thermal storage device and refrigeration equipment

for cooling and charging the device; overall performance is rated by the manufacturer.

Usable cooling. Amount of energy that can actually be delivered to the system or process to meet cooling requirements. Normally, this is the total value of the energy retrieved by supplying the medium at or below the maximum beneficial cooling temperature.

Classification of Systems

Thermal storage systems can be classified according to the type of thermal storage medium, whether they store primarily sensible or latent energy, or the way the storage medium is used. Cool storage media include chilled water, aqueous or nonaqueous fluids, ice, and phase-change materials. Heat storage media include water, brick, stone, ceramic, and phase-change materials. These media differ in their heat storage capacities, the temperatures at which energy is stored, and physical requirements of storing energy in the media. Types of cool storage systems include chilled-water storage, chilled-fluid storage, ice harvesting, internal- and external-melt ice-on-coil, encapsulated ice, ice slurry, phase-change material, and unitary systems. Types of heat storage systems include brick storage heaters, water storage heaters, and radiant floor heating systems, as well as solar space and water heating and thermally charged water storage tanks.

Storage Media

A wide range of materials can be used as thermal storage media. Materials used for thermal storage should be

- Commonly available
- Low cost
- Environmentally benign
- Nonflammable
- Nonexplosive
- Nontoxic
- Compatible with common HVAC equipment construction materials
- Noncorrosive
- Inert

An ideal thermal storage medium should also have

- Well-documented physical properties
- High density
- High specific heat (for sensible heat storage)
- High heat of fusion (for latent heat storage)
- Good heat transfer characteristics
- Stable properties that do not change over many thermal cycles

Common storage media for sensible energy storage include water, fluid, soil, rock, brick, ceramics, concrete, and various portions of the building structure (or process fluid) being heated or cooled. In HVAC applications, such as air conditioning, space heating, and water heating, water is often the chosen sensible storage medium because it provides many of these desirable characteristics when kept between its freezing and boiling points. For high-temperature energy storage, the storage medium is often rock, brick, or ceramic materials for residential or small commercial applications; oil, oil/rock combinations, or molten salt are often used for large industrial or solar energy power plant applications. Using the building structure itself as passive thermal storage offers advantages under some circumstances (Morris et al. 1994).

Common storage media for latent energy storage include ice, aqueous brine/ice solutions, and other PCMs such as eutectic or hydrated salts and polymers. Carbon dioxide and paraffin waxes are among the alternative storage media used for latent energy storage at various temperatures. For air-conditioning applications, ice is the most common latent storage medium, because it provides many of the previously listed desirable characteristics.

Basic Thermal Storage Concepts

The fundamental characteristic of thermal storage systems is that they separate the time(s) of generation of heating or cooling from the time(s) of its use. This separation allows thermal storage systems to generate heating or cooling during periods when conditions are most favorable (e.g., the primary energy source is more available or less expensive), which can be independent of the instantaneous thermal load.

A thermal storage system can meet the same total heating or cooling load as a nonstorage system over a given period of time with smaller primary equipment. The total capacity distributed over the period is matched more closely to the total load encountered in the same period. The reduced size and cost of heating or cooling equipment can partially or completely offset the cost of the storage equipment.

Benefits of Thermal Storage

Properly designed, installed, and operated thermal storage systems offer the following benefits for heating and cooling systems, building owners, operators, and utilities.

Energy Cost Savings. The primary benefit of thermal storage is its ability to substantially reduce total operating costs, particularly for systems using electricity as the primary energy source. Thermal storage systems reduce the demand for expensive on-peak electric power, substituting less expensive off-peak or renewably generated power to do the same job. In addition, in many cases thermal energy storage systems actually consume less energy to deliver the same amount of cooling, primarily because of more efficient use of cooling equipment and the constant temperature of the delivered medium.

Ancillary Services Benefit. Fast-acting and/or grid-interactive energy storage systems can offer additional services to electric grid operators, who must continually balance the system and maintain tight control of system frequency. To do so, power generation must be turned up or down on a second-to-second basis to provide frequency control. This is costly for utilities and ISOs when using traditional fossil fuel generation. Fast-acting, grid-interactive energy storage systems can provide low-carbon regulation and balancing services and can receive attractive compensation for doing so.

Reduced Equipment Size. Heating or cooling equipment can be sized to meet the average load rather than the peak load, and the thermal storage system can be sized to pick up the difference in the load.

Capital Cost Savings. The capital savings from downsizing cooling equipment can more than offset the added cost of the storage system (Andrepont 2005). Cool storage integrated with low-temperature air and water distribution systems can also provide an initial cost savings by using smaller chillers, pumps, piping, ducts, and fans. Smaller cooling equipment often allows designers to downsize the transformers and electrical distribution systems that supply power for cooling. This economic benefit can be significant, both in new construction, and in existing facilities where electrical systems are at or near their full capacity. In some areas, government or utility company incentives are available that can further reduce capital costs.

Energy Savings. Although thermal storage systems are generally designed primarily to shift energy use rather than to conserve energy, they can fill both roles. Cool storage systems allow chillers to operate more at night, when lower condensing temperatures improve equipment efficiency. In addition, thermal storage allows operation of equipment at full load, avoiding inefficient part-load performance. Documented examples include chilled-water storage installations that reduce annual energy consumption on a megajoule (kilowatt-hour) basis for air conditioning by up to 12% (Bahnfleth and Joyce 1994; Fiorino 1994). Heat recovery from chiller condens-

ers can also reduce, or even eliminate, the need for heating equipment and associated energy use by combining cooling thermal storage with heating thermal storage (Goss et al. 1996).

Improved HVAC Operation. Thermal storage allows the thermal load profile to be decoupled from operation of the heating or cooling equipment. This decoupling enables plants to use the optimum combination of primary equipment and storage at any given time, providing increased flexibility, reliability, and efficiency in all seasons.

Back-Up Capacity. Cool storage can substantially reduce the installed cost for back-up or emergency cooling systems by reducing the need for redundant electrical and mechanical equipment. Back-up cooling for critical areas (e.g., computer rooms, hospital operating rooms) can be immediately available from the storage reservoir.

Extending Existing Systems' Capacity. The apparent capacity of existing systems can often be increased by installing cool storage at less cost than adding conventional nonstorage equipment. A chilled-water storage tank adds cooling capacity to an existing system and may avoid the high expense of installing new chillers. With this form of thermal storage, existing chillers can now operate during normally off hours to generate the additional cooling needed. The cooling capability of existing ductwork and piping can also be increased by using cool storage. Supplying chilled water and air at lower temperatures allows existing distribution systems to meet substantially higher loads and reduces pump or fan energy consumption.

Distributed Energy Resource for Utilities. Using TES systems in a utility's service territory may provide the utility with a controllable distributed energy resource through a smart grid. This resource can allow the utility to dynamically reshape the load curve by reducing peak demand and shifting energy use to off-peak periods, thereby improving system efficiency and potentially increasing grid reliability. This can also allow utilities to reliably integrate intermittent renewable energy resources into their systems.

Renewable Energy Integration. With the deployment of larger amounts of renewable energy, electricity supply sometimes exceeds demand, placing pressure on grid operators to curtail further generation. Thermal storage can be used by grid operators to store renewable energy at times when supply exceeds demand.

Other Benefits. Thermal storage can bring about other beneficial synergies. As already noted, cool storage can be integrated with cold-air distribution. A chilled-water storage tank can serve double duty by providing a fire protection water supply at a much lower cost than installing separate systems (Holness 1992; Hussain and Peters 1992; Meckler 1992). Some cool storage systems can be configured for charging with free cooling. Thermal storage can also be used to recover waste energy from base-loaded steam plants by storing chilled water produced by an absorption chiller for later use on demand.

Design Considerations

Thermal storage systems must be designed to meet the total integrated load as well as the peak hourly load. To properly size a thermal storage system, a designer must calculate an accurate load profile and analyze the thermal performance of the storage equipment over the entire storage cycle. Proper sizing is essential. An undersized thermal storage system is limited in its ability to recover when the load exceeds its capacity. On the other hand, excessive oversizing quickly diminishes the economic benefits of thermal storage. Load calculations and system sizing are discussed in Dorgan and Elleson (1993).

Thermal performance of a thermal storage device varies, depending on the current inventory of stored energy and rate of discharge. Therefore, the total capacity of a given thermal storage device depends on the load profile to which it is subjected. There is no standard method for rating cool storage capacity, so performance specifications must detail the required thermal performance for each hour of the storage cycle. Thermal performance specifications for cool storage systems are discussed in AHRI *Guideline* T.

A thermal storage system must be controlled according to two separate time schedules. Generation of heating or cooling is controlled on a different schedule from the distribution and use.

Thermal storage offers the flexibility to supply heating or cooling from storage, from primary equipment, or from both. With this flexibility comes the need to define how the system will be controlled at any given time. The intended strategy for operation and control must be defined as part of the design procedure, as described in Dorgan and Elleson (1993).

1. SENSIBLE THERMAL STORAGE TECHNOLOGY

Sensible Energy Storage

Water is well suited for both hot and cold sensible energy storage applications and is the most common sensible storage medium, in part because it has the highest specific heat [4.18 kJ/(kg·K)] of all common materials. Tanks are available in many shapes; however, vertical cylinders are the most common. Tanks can be located above ground, partially buried, or completely buried. They can also be incorporated into the building structure. For economic reasons, they usually operate at atmospheric pressure and may have clear-span dome roofs, column-supported shallow cone roofs, or column-supported flat roofs. Sensible thermal storage vessels must separate the cooler and warmer volumes of storage medium. This section focuses on chilled-water thermal energy storage because it is the most common system type. However, similar techniques apply to hot-water sensible energy storage for heating systems and to aqueous and nonaqueous stratification fluids for cool storage.

Temperature Range and Storage Size

The cooling capacity of a chilled-water storage vessel is proportional to the volume of water stored and the temperature differential Δt between the stored cool water and returning warm water. There is a direct relationship between Δt and the size of sensible storage system components. For economical storage, therefore, the cooling loads served by the system should provide as large a Δt as practical. Many chilled-water systems are designed to operate with a Δt between supply and return of 7 to 9 K. Designing for an achievable 11 to 13 K Δt may decrease storage vessel size by as much as 50% relative to this typical range. The cost of the extra coil surface required to provide this larger Δt can be more than offset by cost reductions of a smaller tank, reduced pipe and insulation size, and significantly reduced pumping energy. Storage is likely to be uneconomical if the Δt is less than about 5 K because the tank must be so large (Caldwell and Bahnfleth 1997). Typical design and operating conditions result in a storage density of approximately 30 L/MJ (108 L/kWh). Maintaining a Δt as large as possible is very important in achieving the intended beneficial performance of the system. The total performance depends on the behavior of connected loads and needs to be addressed as a system issue.

The initial cost of chilled-water cool storage benefits from a dramatic economy of scale; that is, large installations can be much less expensive per amount of discharge than equivalent nonstorage chilled-water plants (Andrepont 1992, 2005; Andrepont and Kohlenberg 2005; Andrepont and Rice 2002).

Techniques for Thermal Separation in Sensible Storage Devices

The following methods have been applied in chilled-water storage. Thermal stratification is the dominant method because of its simplicity, reliability, efficiency, and low cost. The other methods are described only for reference.

Thermal Stratification. In stratified cool storage, warmer, less dense return water floats on top of denser chilled water. Cool water from storage is supplied and withdrawn at low velocity, in essentially horizontal flow, so buoyancy forces dominate inertial effects. Pure water is most dense at 4.0°C; therefore, colder water introduced into the bottom of a stratified tank tends to mix to this temperature with warmer water in the tank. However, low-temperature fluids (LTFs), typically water with various admixtures, can be used to achieve lower delivery temperatures, larger temperature differences, and thus smaller storage volumes per megajoule (Andrepont 2000; Borer and Schwartz 2005).

When the stratified storage tank is charged, chilled supply water, typically between 3 and 6.7°C, enters through the diffuser at the bottom of the tank (Figure 1), and the warmer return water exits to the chiller through the diffuser at the top of the tank. Typically, incoming water mixes with water in the tank to form a 0.3 to 0.6 m thick thermocline, which is a region with sharp vertical temperature and density gradients (Figure 2). The thermocline minimizes further mixing of the water above it with that below it. The thermocline rises as charging continues and subsequently falls during discharging. It may thicken somewhat during charging and discharging because of heat conduction through the water and heat transfer to and from the walls of the tank. The initial thermocline formation is the principal determiner for overall tank efficiency: formation of the thinnest possible thermocline provides the greatest usable volume. Therefore, careful consideration of diffuser design is needed. The storage tank may have any cross section, but the walls are usually vertical. Horizontal cylindrical tanks are generally not good candidates for stratified storage, because of the ratio of the volume of water within and outside the thermocline.

Multiple Compartments or Multiple Tanks. Multiple compartments in a single tank or a series of two or more tanks can also be used for chilled-water storage. Water may flow through compartments in series, with opposite flow directions during charging and discharging. In empty tank systems, there is one more compartment than required to contain the full stored volume. During charging and discharging, one of the full compartments is emptied while the empty compartment is filled. This is done sequentially until charging or discharging is complete. Consequently, warmer and cooler water never occupy a tank at the same time. This procedure allows using horizontal or vertical tanks of any configuration and size; drawbacks are the complexity of controls and the need to have an empty tank.

Labyrinth Tank. This storage tank has both horizontal and vertical traverses. The design commonly takes the form of successive cubicles with high and low ports, requiring the water to move from a high to a low port as the storage tank is being charged and the opposite as the tank is being discharged. Strings of cylindrical tanks and tanks with successive vertical weirs may also be used for this technique.

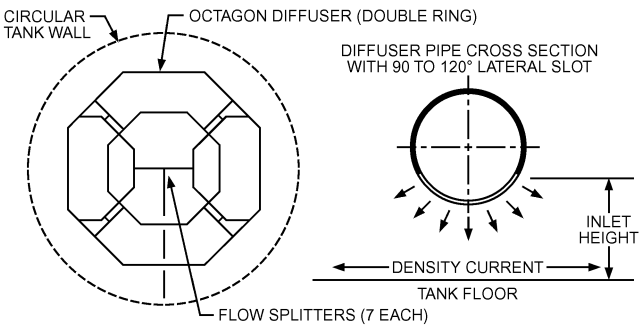

Fig. 1 Typical Two-Ring Octagonal Slotted Pipe Diffuser

Performance of Chilled-Water Storage Systems

A perfect sensible storage device would deliver water at the same temperature at which it was initially stored. This would also require that water returning to storage neither mix with nor exchange heat with stored water in the tank or the surroundings of the tank. In practice, however, all three types of heat exchange occur.

Typical temperature profiles of water entering and leaving a storage tank are shown in Figure 3. Tran et al. (1989) tested several large chilled-water storage systems and developed the **figure of merit (FOM)**, which is used as a measure of the amount of cooling available from the storage tank.

$$\text{FOM} = \frac{\text{Area between } A \text{ and } C}{\text{Area between } A \text{ and } D} \times 100 \quad (1)$$

Well-designed storage tanks have figures of merit of 90% or higher for daily complete charge/discharge cycles.

Design of Stratification Diffusers

Diffusers must be designed and constructed to produce and maintain stratification at the maximum expected flow rate through storage. Two main styles are in widespread use: the octagonal pipe diffuser (see Figure 1) and the radial disk diffuser (Figure 4). Inlet

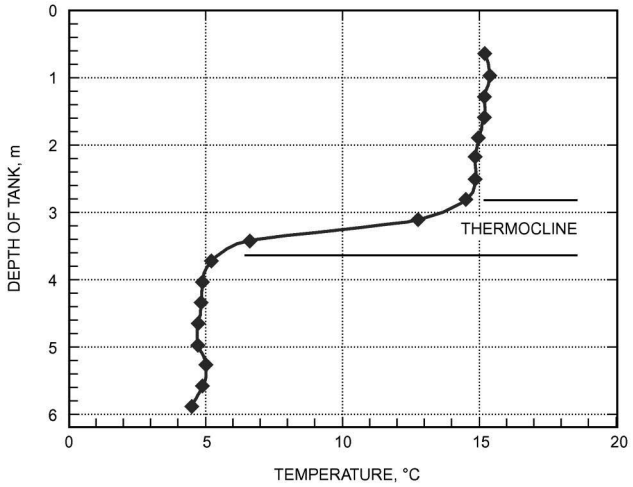

Fig. 2 Typical Temperature Stratification Profile in Storage Tank

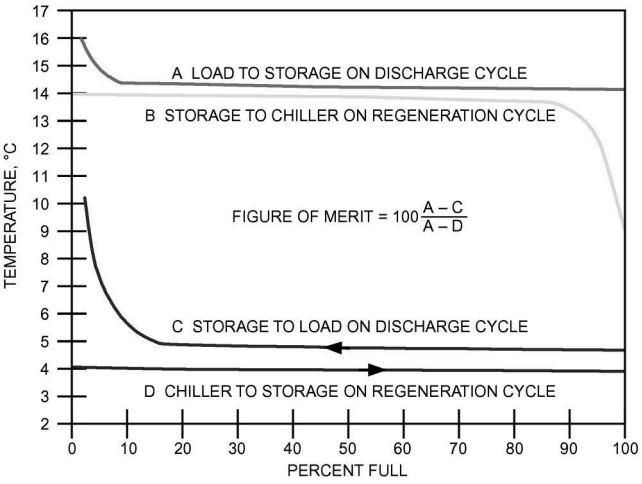

Fig. 3 Typical Chilled-Water Storage Profiles

Table 1 Chilled-Water Density Table

°C	kg/m³	°C	kg/m³	°C	kg/m³
0	999.87	7	999.93	14	999.27
1	999.93	8	999.88	15	999.13
2	999.97	9	999.81	16	998.97
3	999.99	10	999.73	17	998.80
4	1000.00	11	999.63	18	998.62
5	999.99	12	999.52	19	998.43
6	999.97	13	999.40	20	998.23

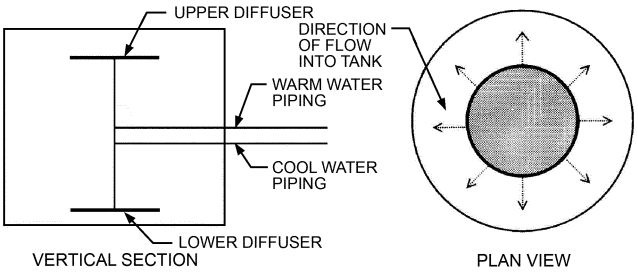

Fig. 4 Radial Disk Diffuser

and outlet streams must be kept at sufficiently low velocities, so buoyancy predominates over inertia to produce a gravity current (density current) across the bottom or top of the tank. This relationship between the buoyancy and inertial forces is expressed in a dimensionless form known as the Froude number.

The inlet Froude number Fr is defined as

$$\mathrm{Fr} = \frac{Q}{\sqrt{gh^3(\Delta\rho/\rho)}} \tag{2}$$

where

Q = volume flow rate per unit length of diffuser, $m^3/(s \cdot m)$
g = gravitational acceleration, m/s^2
h = inlet opening height, m
ρ = inlet water density, kg/m^3
$\Delta\rho$ = difference in density between stored water and incoming or outflowing water, kg/m^3

The density difference $\Delta\rho$ can be obtained from Table 1. The inlet Reynolds number Re is defined as follows:

$$\mathrm{Re} = Q/v \tag{3}$$

where v = kinematic viscosity, m^2/s.

Designers typically select values for Re, which determines the diffuser length, then select a value for the diffuser height to create an inlet Froude number of 1.0 or less. However, values up to 2.0 have been successfully applied (Yoo et al. 1986). Some experimental evidence indicates that the intensity of mixing near the inlet diffuser is influenced by the inlet Reynolds number (Equation [3]).

Wildin and Truman (1989), observing results from a 4.6 m deep, 6.1 m, diameter vertical cylindrical tank, found that reducing the inlet Reynolds number from 850 (using a radial disk diffuser) to 240 (using a diffuser comprised of pipes in an octagonal array) reduced mixing to negligible proportions. This is consistent with subsequent results obtained by Wildin (1991, 1996) in a 0.9 m deep scale model tank, which indicated negligible mixing at Reynolds numbers below approximately 450, with the best performance achieved during testing at a Reynolds number of 250.

Bahnfleth and Joyce (1994), Musser and Bahnfleth (1998, 1999), and Stewart (2001) documented successful operation of tanks with water depths greater than 13.7 m for design inlet Reynolds numbers as high as 10 000, although thermal performance of these systems improved at lower inlet Reynolds numbers.

A parametric study of radial diffusers by Musser and Bahnfleth (2001) found that using Froude numbers less than 1.0 significantly improved performance. Their work, based on field measurements and simulation, confirmed that the Froude number is a parameter of first-order significance for radial diffuser inlet thermal performance, but did not indicate strong effects of varying the Re. They found that parameters relating diffuser and tank dimensions (i.e., ratio of diffuser diameter to diffuser height and ratio of diffuser diameter to tank diameter) had a stronger effect on performance and could explain some of the behavior attributed to Re by earlier research. A similar study of octagonal diffusers by Bahnfleth et al. (2003a) also indicated that diffuser/tank parameters not previously used in design could be of greater significance than Re. They also concluded that diffuser/tank interaction parameters could be important factors in octagonal diffuser performance, and that radial and pipe diffusers are not well described by a single design method.

Because a chilled-water system may experience severe pressure spikes (water hammer), such as during rapid closing of control or isolation valves, the structural design of diffusers should consider this potential event. In addition, the diffusers themselves can also be subjected to buoyancy effects during initial filling or in the rare instance where air entrained in the chilled-water system becomes trapped in the piping and flows to the diffuser. Design and operational considerations should be made to allow any trapped air to escape from the diffuser piping with little or no effect on diffuser performance.

Storage Tank Insulation

Exposed tank surfaces should be well insulated to help maintain the temperature differential in the tank. Insulation is especially important for smaller storage tanks because the ratio of surface area to stored volume is relatively high. Heat transfer between the stored water and tank contact surfaces (including divider walls) is a primary source of capacity loss. In addition to heat losses or gains by conduction through the floor and wall, heat flows vertically along the tank walls from the warmer to the cooler region. Exterior insulation of the tank walls does not totally inhibit this heat transfer.

The contents of chilled-water storage tanks are typically colder than the ambient dew-point temperature, so it is important that the insulation system use a high-integrity exterior vapor barrier to minimize ingress of moisture and condensation into the insulation system.

Other Factors

The cost of chemicals for water treatment may be significant, especially if the tank is filled more than once during its life. A filter system helps keep stored water clean. Exposure of stored water to the atmosphere may require the occasional addition of biocides. Although tanks should be designed to prohibit leakage, the designer should understand the potential effect of leakage on the selection of chemical water treatment. Water treatment based on requirements for a truly open system such as a condenser water system may be excessive, because water in a stratified tank is not aerated and is exposed to the atmosphere only through a small vent at the top of the storage tank. Owners should be careful to consider all factors involved when implementing a water treatment plan. The water treatment should be flexible based on the quantity of makeup water added to the system. See the Water Treatment section for more information.

The storage circulating pumps should be installed below the minimum operating water level of the lowest tank to ensure a continuously pressurized flooded suction. The required net positive suction pressure (NPHP) must be maintained to avoid cavitation of the pumps.

Chilled-Water Storage Tanks

Chilled-water storage systems are typically of large capacity and volume. As a result, many stratified chilled-water storage systems are located outdoors (e.g., in industrial plants or suburban campus locations). A tall tank is desirable for stratification, but a buried tank may be required for architectural, aesthetic, or zoning reasons. Tanks are typically constructed of steel or prestressed concrete to specifications used for municipal water storage tanks. Prestressed concrete tanks can be partially or completely buried below grade. For tanks that are completely buried, the tank roof can be free-standing dome construction, or column-supported for heavy roof loads such as parking lots, tennis courts, or parks.

Low-Temperature Fluid Sensible Energy Storage

Low-temperature fluids (LTFs) may be used as a sensible cool storage medium instead of water. Using an LTF can allow sensible energy thermal storage at temperatures below 4°C, the temperature at which the maximum density of plain water occurs. Thus, LTFs can allow lower-temperature applications of sensible energy storage, such as for low-temperature air conditioning and some food processing applications. LTFs can be either aqueous solutions containing a chemical additive, or nonaqueous chemicals. Several potential LTFs were identified by Stewart (2000). One LTF has been in continuous commercial service in a stratified thermal storage tank in a very large district cooling system since 1994, and has exhibited good corrosion inhibition and microbiological control properties (Andrepont 2000, 2006).

Storage in Aquifers

Aquifers are underground, water-yielding geological formations, either unconsolidated (gravel and sand) or consolidated (rocks), that can be used to store large quantities of thermal energy. In general, the natural aquifer water temperature is slightly warmer than the local mean annual air temperature. Aquifer thermal energy storage has been used for process cooling, space cooling, space heating, and ventilation air preheating (Jenne 1992). Aquifers can be used as heat pump sinks or sources and to store energy from ambient winter air, waste heat, and renewable sources. For more information, see Chapter 35 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

The thickness and porosity of the aquifer determine the storage volume. Two separate wells are normally used to charge and discharge aquifer storage. A well pair may be pumped either (1) constantly in one direction or (2) alternately from one well to the other, especially when both heating and cooling are provided. Backflushing is recommended to maintain good well efficiency.

The length of storage depends on the local climate and the type of building or process being supplied with cooling or heating. Aquifer thermal energy storage may be used on a short- or long-term basis, as the sole source of energy or as partial storage, and at a temperature useful for direct application or needing augmentation by boilers or chillers. It may also be used in combination with a dehumidification system, such as desiccant cooling. The cost effectiveness of aquifer thermal energy storage is based on the avoidance of equipment capital cost and on lower operating cost.

Aquifer thermal energy storage may be incorporated into a building system in a variety of ways, depending on the other components present and the intentions of the designer (CSA *Standard* C44793; Hall 1993). Control is simplified by separate hot and cold wells that operate on the basis that the last water in is the first water out. This principle ensures that the hottest or coldest water is always available when needed.

Seasonal storage has a large savings potential and began as an environmentally sensitive improvement on the large-scale mining of groundwater (Hall 1993). The current method reinjects all pumped water to attempt annual thermal balancing (Morofsky 1994; Public Works Canada 1991, 1992; Snijders 1992). Rock caverns have also been used successfully in a manner similar to aquifers to store energy. For example, Oulu, Finland, stores hot water in a cavern for district heating.

Chilled-Water Thermal Storage Sizing Examples

Examples 1 and 2 show different methods to size a stratified chilled-water (CHW) TES system based on daily cooling load shifting. The CHW thermal storage system size includes both the size of the TES tank itself and the size of the chillers needed to charge the system. To determine the size of a thermal storage system, the peak-day 24 h cooling load profile must be available either from actual facility data or from engineering cooling load estimates. For sizing purposes, the peak-day 24 h cooling load profile is the day with the largest total kilowatt-hours, which is often the day with the highest instantaneous peak cooling load. For more information, see the section on Sizing Cool Storage Systems.

With chilled-water thermal storage, two sizing options are typically used: full storage and partial storage. With **full storage**, the thermal storage system is sized so that on the peak day, with the exception of chilled-water distribution pumps, the chiller plant can be completely turned off for a certain period of the day (usually the utility company's on-peak period). With **partial storage**, the thermal storage system is sized such that, on the peak cooling day, the smallest chiller plant possible can meet the peak cooling load by operating at a constant rate throughout the day in conjunction with the thermal storage system. That is, partial storage requires the chiller plant to operate during the entire day, including the on-peak period.

Example 1: Full Storage System Sizing. To determine the required full-storage TES capacity and corresponding required total chiller plant capacity, construct a simple hour-by-hour spreadsheet model, as shown in Table 2. The required information is the peak-day 24 h cooling load profile, which should be the day with the facility's maximum total daily kilowatt-hours. The total daily kilowatt-hours is the sum of the day's individual hourly average cooling loads (i.e., the area under the daily cooling load curve shown in Figure 5). In Table 2, this value is equal to 156 235 kWh.

The total 24 h chiller plant output in kilowatt-hours m*ust* equal the facility's peak-day total daily kilowatt-hours demand. For full-storage systems, the chillers will be off during the utility on-peak period, which in this example is a 4 h period from 1 PM to 5 PM. Therefore, the minimum chiller plant capacity is calculated as approximately 7814 kW (156 235 kWh/20 h rounded up), and is entered into the spreadsheet sizing model (Table 2).

Note minor chiller operating adjustments are made to equalize the total kilowatt-hours; so, in this example, 7761 kW is entered at the 12 PM hour. If actual chiller plant capacity is larger than the calculated minimum chiller plant capacity required, use the capacity of the larger chiller plant in the spreadsheet model, which causes the calculated size of the proposed TES tank to be somewhat smaller than in the case with minimum-sized chiller plant capacity.

The last column in Table 2 calculates the total TES tank charge for each hour. The calculated minimum TES tank size is simply the maximum value calculated in the TES tank charge column, which in this example is 44 513 kWh. The first step in calculating the maximum TES tank charge is to identify the hour at which the TES tank runs out of capacity and enter a zero value in that cell. This time is determined by noting the hour at which chiller plant capacity is greater than the facility cooling load, and hence the hour that the chiller plant can start charging the TES tank. Further, observe that, by design, the TES tank becomes fully discharged the hour before this time. As shown in the Table 2 full-storage example, the facility cooling load falls below chiller plant output at 7 PM, so the zero value is entered for TES charge at 6 PM. The formula for TES tank capacity at 7 PM and for all other hours in the day is to add the previous hour's TES tank charge to the difference between chiller plant output and facility cooling load. When the difference between chiller plant output and facility cooling load is positive, the system is charging the TES tank; conversely, when the difference is negative, the TES tank is discharging to serve the facility's cooling load demand. In this example, the 7 PM hour TES tank charge is 510 kWh, equal to the

Table 2 Peak Day Full-Storage TES Sizing Calculations

		Chilled Water TES System	
Time of Day*	Facility Hourly CHW Load, kW	Centrifugal Chiller Output, kW	TES Charge, kWh
12:00 AM	3833	7814	11 834
1:00	3584	7814	16 065
2:00	3373	7814	20 507
3:00	3429	7814	24 892
4:00	3408	7814	29 299
5:00	3404	7814	33 709
6:00	4480	7814	37 043
7:00	4776	7814	40 082
8:00	5124	7814	42 772
9:00	6235	7814	44 351
10:00	7653	7814	44 513
11:00	8820	7814	43 507
12:00 PM	9383	7761	41 885
1:00	9963	0	31 922
2:00	10 200	0	21 722
3:00	10 200	0	11 522
4:00	9791	0	1731
5:00	9102	7814	444
6:00	8258	7814	0
7:00	7304	7814	510
8:00	6840	7814	1484
9:00	6457	7814	2842
10:00	6017	7814	4639
11:00	4600	7814	7853
Total	**156 235**	**156 235**	
TES Tank Size, kWh			**44 153**

*This example's on-peak electricity demand period is highlighted in the table for reference.

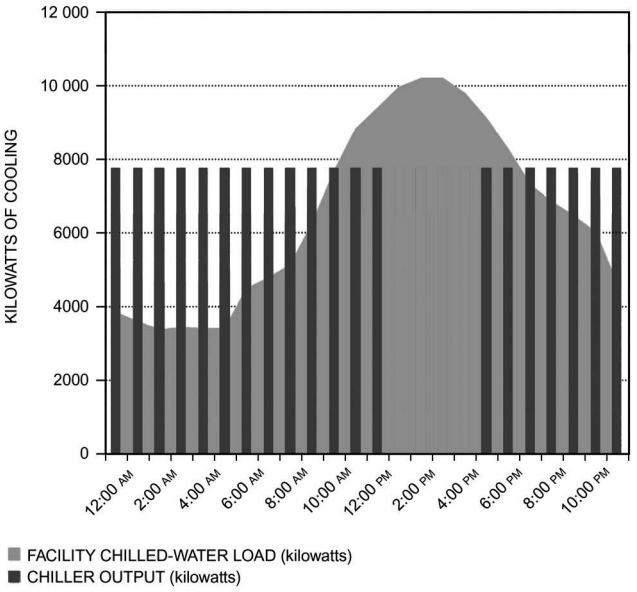

Fig. 5 Full-Storage TES Tank Peak-Day Operation: Facility Cooling Load Versus Chiller Output

6 PM hour TES tank charge of 0 kWh plus 7814 kW minus 7304 kW. Similarly, the 8 PM hour TES tank capacity is 1484 kWh, equal to 510 kWh plus 7814 kW minus 6840 kW. The midnight-hour TES tank charge at the top of the column references the 11 PM hour TES tank charge value at the bottom of the column (i.e., the calculation loops to complete the 24 h cycle).

Depending on how much of a safety factor is in the peak-day 24 h cooling load profile, it is probably prudent to add some additional capacity to the minimum TES tank size and to the chiller plant capacity calculated. For example, to prevent unintended on-peak operation,

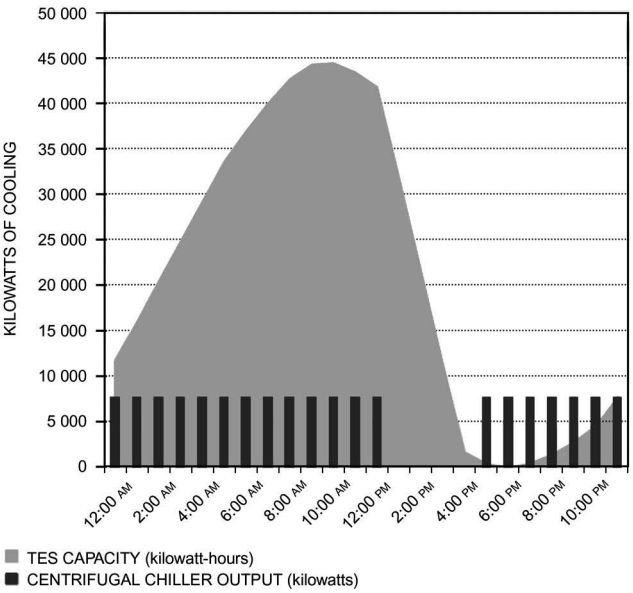

Fig. 6 TES Tank Full-Storage Capacity (kWh) and Chiller Operation Output (kW)

chillers may need to be shut down slightly before the on-peak period starts (e.g., 12:45 PM), and chiller start-up may take some time after the end of the on-peak period.

For the example designed and shown in Table 2, the chilled-water TES tank is completely discharged of chilled water by the end of the 6:00 PM hour. Starting at 5:00 PM (which is the end of the on-peak period in this example), the chiller plant is operated, and, on a peak day, continues to operate to serve facility cooling loads and to charge the TES tank until the start of the on-peak demand period (1:00 PM) on the following day. In this example, the facility cooling load rises above the chiller plant output at 11:00 AM and the TES tank begins the discharge mode. Per design, the chillers are completely shut down for the 4 h on-peak period of the day, and the TES tank discharges to deliver the chilled water required to serve the facility on-peak cooling loads. When the TES tank is fully discharged, the daily process starts again.

Note the minimum full-storage TES tank size is the sum of the on-peak hours, which in this case is 40 514 kWh as shown in the following excerpted table; however, if the TES tank were sized for this capacity, a larger chiller plant would be required. On-peak facility loads are as follows:

1:00 PM	9963
2:00 PM	10 200
3:00 PM	10 200
4:00 PM	9791
Total kWh	**40 154**

As can be determined by evaluating the spreadsheet model, the chiller plant capacity needed to make this minimum-sized full-storage TES capacity of 40 154 kWh work properly is 9383 kW 1569 kW more than the minimum chiller size case), because the chiller plant has to meet the 11 AM cooling load and keep the TES tank fully charged. Note also that this minimum TES tank capacity does not allow for spare thermal storage capacity at the end of the on-peak period, which is needed while the chiller plant is brought online (the chiller is typically not started all at once). Figures 5 and 6 show the TES system operations for this example.

Given a required thermal storage capacity in kilowatt-hours (44 513 kWh in this example) and the CHW system Δt, the TES tank volume can be calculated as follows:

$$V = \frac{X 3\ 600\ 000\ \text{J/kWh}}{c_p \Delta t \times \text{SG}(998\ \text{kg/m}^3)\text{FOM}} \quad (4)$$

where

V = TES tank volume, m^3
X = amount of thermal capacity required, kWh
c_p = specific heat of water, 4184 J/(kg·K
Δt = temperature difference, K
SG = specific gravity
FOM = storage efficiency, typically 0.9

The tank's figure of merit (efficiency) depends on thermocline thickness and tank depth, as well as the space above and below the diffusers, which is typically not included in usable space. Although 90% is commonly used, the engineer needs to determine the appropriate value.

In this example, assuming a 9 K Δt, the TES tank volume [44 513 kWh × 3 600 000 J/(kg·K)]/[4184 J/(kg·K) × 9 K × 1 × 998 kg/m^3 × 0.9] = 4738 m^3.

With the TES tank volume determined, the TES tank dimensions can then be calculated, because cylindrical tank volume equals tank height times tank floor area, which is equal to π times the radius squared ($V = h\pi R^2$). For example, using a cylindrical tank with a radius of 10 m, the required water height in the proposed TES tank is approximately

$$4738\ m^3/[3.14 \times (10\ m)^2] = 15\ m$$

The actual total tank height needs to add required tank freeboard and tank roof slope to the water height. Of course, actual tank configuration depends on several factors, including available area, soil conditions, internal column dimensions, and tank construction cost economics.

Example 2: Partial-Storage System Sizing. Given the peak day 24 h cooling load profile as shown in Table 3, the minimum chiller plant size needed to serve the facility cooling load is determined by dividing the facility total daily cooling load in kilowatt-hours by 24 h. Therefore, the minimum chiller size is the average of the peak day's cooling load. If instantaneous cooling load data are available, the minimum chiller size is the area under the 24 h load curve divided by 24 h. Note, as with full-storage systems, the total daily chiller production kilowatt-hours must equal the daily facility cooling load kilowatt-hour demand.

In this example, as shown in Table 3, the facility daily load is 156 235 kWh. Therefore, the minimum chiller plant capacity required to meet the facility's peak daily cooling load is 6510 kW (156 235 kWh/24 h = 6510 kW, which is the actual number entered into the spreadsheet model; round up and adjust as necessary to match total daily load kilowatt-hours). As noted in Example 1, it is wise to provide some additional chiller capacity in practice. This includes applying a safety factor to the estimated peak-day cooling load profile, and providing one additional chiller above that required to meet peak cooling load with the TES tank in case one chiller is out of commission.

A spreadsheet thermal storage sizing model is constructed in the same manner as described for the previous full-storage example, except that the chiller plant operates during the on-peak period as shown in Table 3.

Table 3 shows that the maximum TES tank charge for this example is 25 905 kWh. The on-peak chiller operation is more than a full-storage case, but less than a conventional chiller plant, which in this example requires almost 10 200 kW of chiller capacity. Further, a chiller plant capacity of 6510 kW is the smallest that can meet the facility's peak daily cooling load of 156 235 kWh.

As shown in Table 3, the chilled-water TES tank is completely discharged of chilled water by the end of the 8:00 PM hour (set the zero value at this hour). Starting at 9:00 PM, the chiller plant produces more chilled water than is needed 6510 kW of chiller operation versus 6457 kW of demand). The net difference of chilled-water production versus demand is stored in the TES tank for use the following day. The chillers operate at a constant output over the day, and at 9:00 AM, the chilled-water TES tank holds its maximum storage charge of 25 905 kWh. At 10:00 AM, the campus cooling load is greater than chiller plant output and the TES tank begins to discharge to serve the campus chilled-water demand in excess of chiller plant output.

The TES tank volume and dimensions can be calculated in the same manner as shown in Example 1. Figures 7 and 8 show the TES system operations for this example.

Table 3 Peak-Day Partial-Storage TES Sizing Calculations

		Chilled Water TES System	
Time of Day*	**Facility Hourly CHW Load, kW**	**Centrifugal Chiller Output, kW**	**TES Charge, kWh**
12:00 AM	3833	6510	5131
1:00	3584	6510	8057
2:00	3373	6510	11 194
3:00	3429	6510	14 275
4:00	3408	6510	17 377
5:00	3404	6510	20 482
6:00	4480	6510	22 511
7:00	4776	6510	24 245
8:00	5124	6510	25 631
9:00	6235	6510	25 905
10:00	7653	6510	24 762
11:00	8820	6510	22 452
12:00 PM	9383	6510	19 578
1:00	9963	6510	16 125
2:00	10200	6510	12 434
3:00	10200	6510	8744
4:00	9791	6510	5463
5:00	9102	6510	2871
6:00	8258	6510	1123
7:00	7304	6510	328
8:00	6840	6510	0
9:00	6457	6510	53
10:00	6017	6510	545
11:00	4600	6510	2455
Total	**156 235**	**156 235**	
TES Tank Size, kWh			**25 905**

*Example 2's on-peak electricity demand period is highlighted for reference.

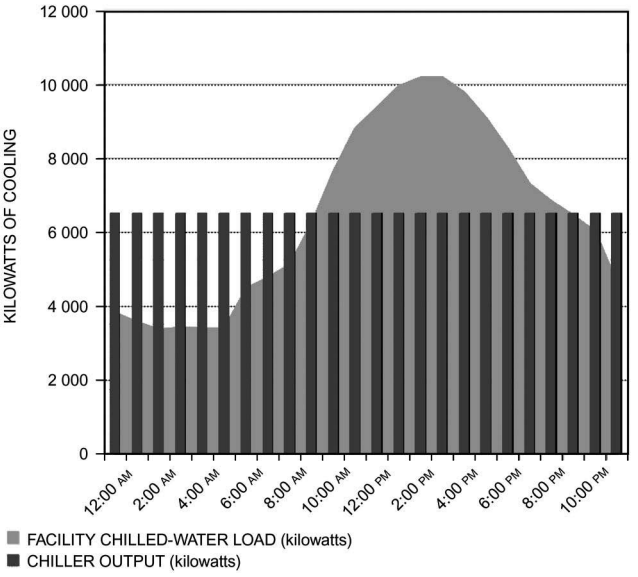

Fig. 7 Cooling Load (kW) and Chiller Load (kW) with Partial-Storage TES Tank

Plant and tank capacities for partial, full, and no TES can be compared as follows:

	No TES	**Partial TES**	**Full TES**
Chiller plant capacity	10 200 kW	6510 kW	7814 kW
TES tank capacity	0 kWh	25 905 kWh	44 153 kWh

2. LATENT COOL STORAGE TECHNOLOGY

Latent cool storage systems achieve most of their capacity from the latent heat of fusion of a phase-change material, although sensible heat contributes significantly to many designs. The high energy density of latent storage systems allows compact installations and makes factory-manufactured components and systems practical. Latent storage devices are available in a wide variety of distinct technologies that sometimes defy accurate classification. Current categories include internal-melt ice-on-coil, external-melt ice-on-coil, encapsulated, ice harvester, ice slurry, and unitary technologies.

A challenge common to all latent energy storage methods is to find an efficient and economical means of achieving the heat transfer necessary to alternately freeze and melt the storage medium. Various methods have been developed to limit or deal with the heat transfer approach temperatures associated with freezing and melting; however, leaving fluid temperatures (from storage during melting) must be higher than the freezing point, and entering fluid temperatures (to storage during freezing) must be lower than the freezing point. Ice storage can provide leaving temperatures well below those normally used for comfort and nonstorage air-conditioning applications. However, entering temperatures are also much lower than normal. Some PCM storage systems can be charged using temperatures near those for comfort cooling, but they produce warmer leaving temperatures.

Water as Phase-Change Thermal Storage Medium

An overwhelming majority of latent storage systems use plain water as the storage medium. A number of other materials have been developed over the years and are sometimes used in unique applications. However, water's combination of reliability, stability, insignificant cost, high latent heat capacity of 335 kJ/kg, high specific heat, high density, safety, and appropriate fusion temperature have proven desirable for many typical HVAC cooling applications.

Water has a very stable melting point of 0°C at sea level. Under some conditions, supercooling can depress the initial freezing point by 1 to 3 K, but impurities found in potable water, random disturbances, minor vibrations, surface interactions, or intentional agitation are generally sufficient to initiate nucleation of ice crystals. Supercooling most often occurs during an initial reduction of the liquid water temperature below 0°C. Residual ice reduces or eliminates the supercooling tendency for subsequent ice-making periods. The amount of supercooling, if experienced at all, is typically 1 to 2 K, and the phase-change temperature rapidly returns to 0°C immediately after this initial nucleation period. With relatively pure water that is isolated from any external influence, a proprietary agent may be used to induce nucleation.

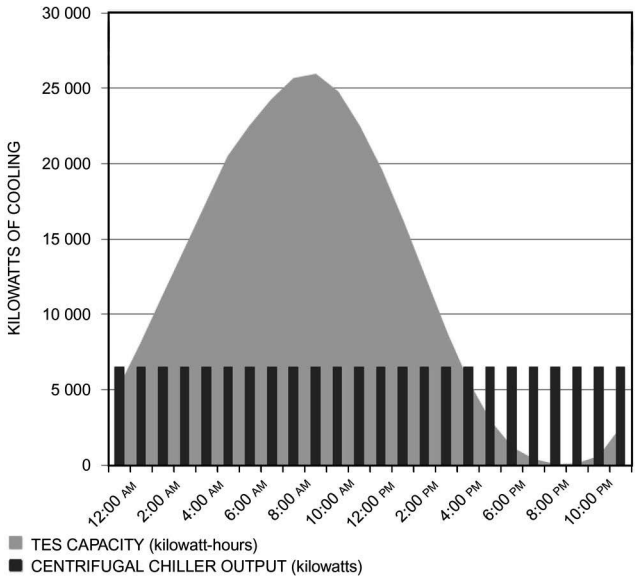

Fig. 8 TES Tank Partial-Storage Capacity (kWh) and Chiller Operation Output (kW)

Water slightly decreases in density below 4°C and expands by about 9% on freezing. This expansion is often used as an indicator of ice inventory where the ice remains completely submerged, such as with the ice-on-coil systems. The ice in most ice-harvesting systems typically floats for most, if not all, of the inventory range, and therefore the water level in the tank does not change as ice is made or melted. End of charge (full capacity) can be identified eventually by the height of the ice when the floor of the tank supports the accumulated ice, as noted in the section on Ice Harvesters.

If the ice is allowed to float in liquid water, the liquid level will remain constant as ice is frozen or melted (as noted in the preceding paragraph). Ice slightly increases in density below the freezing temperature, but this is of little interest in storage systems, which all operate close to the phase-change temperature, and the variation is minor.

Many ice storage technologies use secondary coolants for heat transfer. This allows use of standard chillers, including centrifugals, for ice building and simplifies the application of the technology to typical chilled-water cooling systems. Common secondary coolants have well-documented properties and provide reliable freeze and corrosion protection when properly maintained and installed. The proper concentration for the coolant is selected to provide a freeze point well below the lowest expected coolant temperature. This temperature is determined by the heat transfer characteristics of the storage device, flow rates, and chiller capacity.

Internal Melt Ice-On-Coil

Internal-melt ice-on-coil thermal storage devices circulate a secondary coolant or refrigerant through a tubular heat exchanger that is submersed in a cylindrical or rectangular tank of water. The phase-change water remains in the tank; both charging (ice making) and discharging (ice melting) are accomplished by circulating the secondary heat transfer fluid. Ice forms on the heat exchanger tubes during charging, and melts from the inside out (hence the term internal-melt) during discharging.

Internal-melt storage devices may be provided as complete, modular, factory-assembled units, or may consist of field-erected tanks equipped with prefabricated heat exchangers. Most current designs use secondary coolants (e.g., 25% ethylene glycol/75% water) as the heat transfer fluid.

Storage devices using refrigerant as the heat transfer fluid have also been developed for applications typically served by direct expansion equipment, such as residential and small commercial installations.

Storage device manufacturers typically provide performance data, including at least the average and final charging temperatures as a function of charging rate and flow. The average temperature is useful for selecting chiller capacity and estimating energy consumption. The lowest anticipated temperature is needed to establish chiller protection settings, specify coolant freeze protection requirements, and verify the capabilities of chiller selections, which is particularly important for centrifugal chillers. Glycols are currently the most commonly used secondary coolants, and design practices are conventional, with no exceptional material limitations other than the exclusion of galvanized steel for surfaces in contact with the heat transfer fluid. Proper application of some secondary coolants is addressed in Chapter 13 of the 2022 *ASHRAE Handbook—Refrigeration*.

The tubular heat exchanger is typically constructed of polyethylene or polypropylene plastic, or galvanized steel. Refrigerant-

based systems may use copper. The heat exchanger typically occupies about 10% of the tank volume. Tube spacing is generally closer than in external-melt heat exchangers to compensate for the indirect heat exchange and the gradual development of a liquid annulus in the discharge mode. There is no need to maintain a liquid channel between individual tubes. The entire water volume between heat exchanger tubes is frozen. Approximately 9% of the tank volume, all above the heat exchanger, is reserved for expansion of the water as it freezes. Heat exchange surface does not usually extend into this expansion volume. If water is frozen in this area of the tank, subsequent melting may result in ice remaining in the expansion area, with voids forming around the heat exchange surfaces below. Some manufacturers provide means to prevent this possibility. Because the heat exchanger is prevented from floating, structurally or by its own mass, the rise in water level is proportional to the ice inventory. Level sensors can provide inventory information to the automatic control and/or energy management systems.

Several combinations of tanks and heat exchangers are available for secondary coolant systems. Cylindrical plastic tanks provide a combination of structure, water containment, and corrosion protection, and use a polyolefin heat exchanger, typically formed into a spiral configuration to conform to the tank shape. Structural steel tanks are usually rectangular; water containment can be achieved with either a metal or flexible liner. Steel tanks are often hot-dip galvanized for corrosion protection, and can use either galvanized steel or polyolefin heat exchangers.

Some care is required in the design of external piping because these are often modular systems, sometimes with large numbers of individual tanks arrayed in a variety of patterns. Reverse-return piping is often used to simplify balancing.

An important characteristic of the internal-melt design is the relationship between the charging and discharging processes (Figure 9). During discharge, ice in contact with the heat exchanger is melted first. Initial discharge rates can be very high, and initial available temperatures approach the phase-change temperature. However, as ice melts, an annulus of water develops between the heat exchanger and ice surfaces. This results in variable performance for the internal-melt design. Manufacturers have developed various methods of incorporating the effect of ice inventory levels in product performance descriptions. The temperature of coolant leaving the storage device varies with flow rate, supply temperature, and ice inventory. A mixing or diverting valve is often included to automatically adjust flow through the storage device, controlling both the leaving temperature and discharge rate. Because the storage flow can be completely independent of the chiller flow, cooling load can be imposed on either component in any desired proportion, allowing the designer to optimize discharge of storage for a particular utility rate and building load.

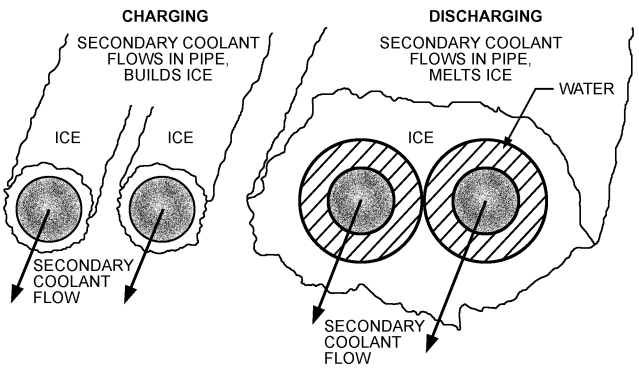

Fig. 9 Charge and Discharge of Internal-Melt Ice Storage

When the internal-melt system returns to ice-making (charging) mode, ice first forms directly on the heat exchanger surface and gradually accumulates, perhaps to a point where it joins with ice remaining from previous charges. Chilled-coolant temperatures are always at their most efficient levels for every ice-building period, and every charge can be carried to completion without penalty. There is usually no benefit to limiting the amount of ice produced, so the storage can be fully charged every night. Because the internal storage temperature is always at the phase-change temperature, standby losses are virtually independent of ice inventory. This simplifies control logic, maximizes efficiency, and eliminates the potential liabilities of predicting the next day's required storage. The close tube spacing needed for good discharge performance provides excellent ice-making performance, because the thermal conductivity of ice is about 3.5 times greater than that of liquid water. Although coolant temperatures depend on many factors, a typical charge cycle begins with coolant temperatures of –3°C entering storage and leaving near 0°C. For most of the charge period, the coolant temperatures are fairly stable, gradually diminishing but with an average supply temperature of approximately –4°C. As the end of the charge mode nears, temperatures decrease at much faster rates to perhaps a minimum supply temperature of –5°C. The rapid temperature decrease at the end of the charge cycle is caused by the exhaustion of latent heat and the lower specific heat of ice compared to liquid water. Depending on system type, a full charge may be indicated by an inventory measurement or a final leaving temperature. The ice-making chiller or compressor is generally fully loaded throughout the ice-making period. Once the ice inventory is completely restored, ice-making chiller operation is terminated to prevent cycling the chiller in the ice-making mode.

3. CHILLER AND ICE STORAGE SELECTION

When selecting chiller and ice storage, follow these steps:

1. Construct design-day load profile
2. Define operating schedule
3. Determine required chiller/storage capacities
4. Select storage equipment

For example, the cooling load profile for the design day (Figure 10) indicates 11 hours of cooling load, from 8 AM to 7 PM. The total cooling load over the entire period is 36 000 kWh, with a peak load of 4000 kW. In this case, assume that the designer has 10 h available to produce the stored cooling. As always for thermal storage, an accurate design-day load profile is essential. If night loads will be served by the storage chillers, they must be included in the total kilowatt-hours.

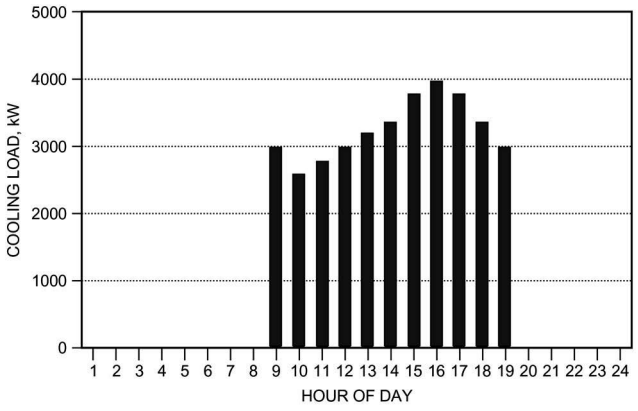

Fig. 10 Design-Day Cooling Load

All loads, including potentially high morning loads for buildings that may be unconditioned through the night, must be accounted for. The minimum-sized chiller and associated storage capacity can be quickly estimated by totaling the available full-load equivalent hours for the chiller and dividing into the total cooling requirement. In the partial storage case, assume that the chiller generates 70% of normal daytime capacity when producing ice and its nominal value when cooling the load directly. This is simply an estimate of the chiller's relative capacity when producing ice, and varies by climate and type of chiller, but values typically fall in the range of 0.65 to 0.75, with water-cooled equipment often toward the higher end. This is a capacity multiplier, not an efficiency multiplier. Efficiencies may be slightly better or worse than daytime values.

$$Q = \frac{\text{TH}}{0.7 \times t_{ice} + t_{cooling}} \quad (5)$$

where

Q = minimum chiller capacity required, kW
TH = total peak day cooling load, kWh
t_{ice} = daily duration chillers are producing ice, h
$t_{cooling}$ = daily duration chillers are providing daytime cooling, h

Thus,

$$Q = \frac{36\ 000}{0.7 \times 10 + 11} = 2000 \text{ kW}$$

So 2000 kW is the minimum chiller capacity that can produce all of the required cooling in a 24 h period.

The amount of storage is 2000 kW × 0.7 × 10 h = 14 000 kWh. In this case, the minimum configuration would be two 1000 kW chillers with 14 000 kWh of storage, providing a potential demand reduction corresponding to 2000 kW of daytime chiller operation (Figure 11).

Other approaches are calculated in a similar manner. For instance, for full storage, simply remove the daytime contribution of the chiller. Full storage might use more no-load hours for chiller storage production, but without daytime chiller operation:

$$Q = \frac{36\ 000}{0.7 \times 12 + 0} = 4285 \text{ kW}$$

Note that this is the nominal (daytime capacity) rating of the chiller, because the hours have been adjusted by the ice-making capacity of 0.7. Of course, the storage requirement is equal to the total cooling load of 36 000 kWh.

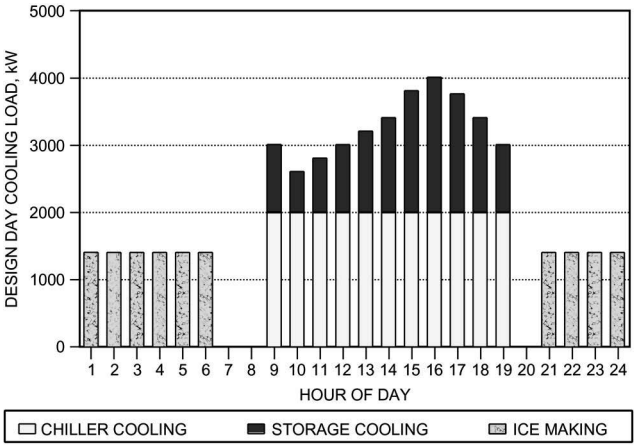

Fig. 11 Minimum-Sized Chilled and Storage Contribution to Cooling Load

Other possible combinations include storage use only for the afternoon, with the chiller serving morning loads directly; this approach is common for utility areas with summer on-peak periods from noon to evening. Base-load chiller capacity could be included to meet nighttime loads, or different numbers of chillers could operate between night and day. It is only necessary to adjust the chiller operating hours and capacity multipliers to reflect the proposed scheduling.

Operation With Disabled Chiller

In the preceding cases, the minimum equipment capacity is calculated. However, storage introduces additional variables when redundancy is considered. In the event of a disabled chiller (1 × 1000 kW) with partial storage, the remaining operable chiller would take advantage of all 13 of the no-load hours to generate as much stored cooling as possible. The system shown in Figure 11 could produce 20 100 kWh of total capacity over 24 h, or about 56% of the design-day loads, comparable to a conventional system with minimum chiller capacity (2 × 2000 kW chillers). Simply including a third, equal-sized chiller (1000 kW) provides 100% redundancy.

Redundancy requirements often are addressed differently. A common conventional approach, without storage, is to add 20% to the design day peak load (4000 kW × 1.2 = 4800 kW) and divide the total into three equal-sized chillers: in this case, three 1600 kW machines. When storage is considered, the same approach can be followed. However, storage is substituted for the third chiller. In this way, similar levels of redundancy are achieved, with better use of installed equipment. In this approach, a broad range of storage capacity can be installed, depending on the chiller operating philosophy. Two 1600 kW chillers can produce up to 22 400 kWh of stored cooling in 10 h. The remaining design day cooling load (36 000 – 22 400 = 13 600 kWh) could be met by a single chiller operating at 1240 kW during the day. Smaller storage capacities just require more chiller contribution during the day. For example, a single 1600 kW chiller could operate at full capacity during the day, reducing the required storage capacity to 18 400 kWh, while still eliminating 2400 kW of on-peak, chiller-related electrical demand.

In the event of a chiller failure, the amount of storage that a single chiller could produce in the 13 no-load hours is 14 560 kW of storage capacity (1600 × 0.7 × 13 = 14 560 kWh). In the failure case, total single-chiller-system capacity would be 32 160 kWh (1600 × 11 + 14 560 = 32 160), or about 89% of the design day ton-hour cooling requirement. This is within a few percent of the conventional system capacity, if one of three chillers were disabled. Depending on the control logic, any shortfall could be distributed over the peak cooling hours, or peak loads could be met and cooling capacity in later hours would be reduced (Figure 12).

Note that for full-storage systems, there is usually 100% redundancy as long as there are multiple chillers. The system simply operates in partial-storage mode with a disabled chiller. Referring to the earlier calculations, one of the two full-storage chillers is approximately the same capacity as both partial-storage chillers combined 2000 kW (nominal), and the storage capacity is much greater than the partial-storage design.

Selecting Storage Equipment

The preceding analysis determines chiller sizes and storage capacity. Storage equipment capable of delivering that capacity must then be selected. The performance of secondary coolant ice storage devices depends on several factors including storage type (e.g., internal/external melt), coolant temperatures, flow rates, and storage inventory (amount of ice remaining). System design also affects storage performance. Supply and return temperatures and component arrangements both influence operating conditions for storage equipment. The designer must ensure that the storage equip-

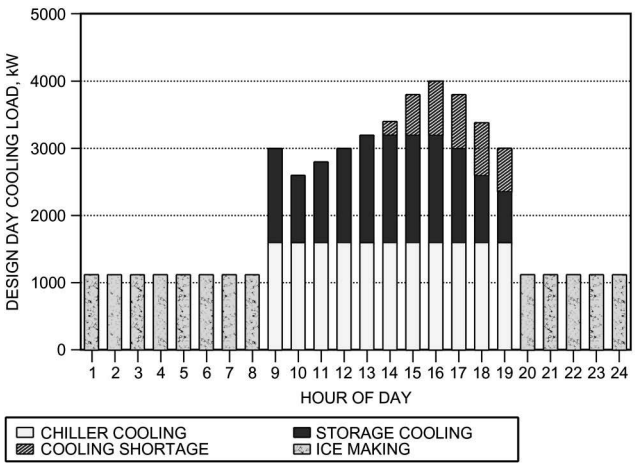

Fig. 12 Redundancy with One of Two Chillers Disabled

Table 4 Design Day Chiller and Storage Load Contributions and Leaving Coolant Temperatures (LCT)

Hour	Cooling Load, kW	Chiller, kW	Storage, kW	Storage Inventory, kWh	Primary Return Temperature, °C	Chiller LCT, °C	Storage LCT, °C
1	0	1400	1400	7000		–3.20	–0.40
2	0	1400	1400	8400		–3.35	–0.55
3	0	1400	1400	9800		–3.60	–0.80
4	0	1400	1400	11 200		–3.90	–1.10
5	0	1400	1400	12 600		–4.35	–1.55
6	0	1400	1400	14 000		–5.00	–2.20
7	0	0	0	14 000		—	—
8	0	0	0	14 000		—	—
9	3000	2000	–1000	13 000	12.0	8.0	0.20
10	2600	2000	–600	12 400	11.2	7.2	0.25
11	2800	2000	–800	11 600	11.6	7.6	0.30
12	3000	2000	–1000	10 600	12.0	8.0	0.55
13	3200	2000	–1200	9400	12.4	8.4	0.75
14	3400	2000	–1400	8000	12.8	8.8	1.35
15	3800	2000	–1800	6200	13.6	9.6	2.65
16	4000	2000	–2000	4200	14.0	10.0	3.95
17	3800	2000	–1800	2400	13.6	9.6	4.55
18	3400	2000	–1400	1000	12.8	8.8	5.10
19	3000	2000	–1000	0	12.0	8.0	6.0
20	0	0	0	0		—	—
21	0	1400	1400	1400		–2.90	–0.10
22	0	1400	1400	2800		–2.95	–0.15
23	0	1400	1400	4200		–3.00	–0.20
24	0	1400	1400	5600		–3.10	–0.30

ment can deliver the required cooling capacity at the proper temperatures throughout the design day.

A common primary/secondary configuration places the chiller and storage in series, with the chiller upstream or downstream of the storage equipment (see Figures 31 and 32). Note that, in this type of system, the coolant temperature leaving the storage equipment varies throughout the day as loads change and ice inventory diminishes. Manufacturers' data are used to simulate storage performance throughout the design day, with a goal of selecting adequate storage capacity so that the storage leaving temperature never exceeds the design supply temperature to the cooling load (6°C in this case).

Using the original, partial-storage example, assume a chiller-upstream system geometry (see Figure 31) with design supply and return temperatures of 6 and 14°C. The chiller contribution is 2000 kW during the on-peak, daytime cooling period, as shown in Figure 11 and Table 4. For a typical primary/secondary design, Table 4 summarizes the hourly conditions on a design day after the proper amount of storage has been determined. In this example, the storage leaving coolant temperature (LCT) is at maximum (6°C) the last cooling hour of the day (i.e., the worst-case hour). Although the cooling load provided by storage is half the peak value, the reduction in ice inventory dominates performance. In some cases, it may be determined that an earlier hour, with higher storage cooling loads but greater ice inventory, is the critical design point.

External-Melt Ice-On-Coil

External-melt ice-on-coil thermal storage devices also consist of a tubular heat exchanger submersed in a cylindrical or rectangular tank of water. However, these devices circulate a secondary coolant through the tubes only for charging. Discharging is accomplished by circulating the water surrounding the heat exchanger. Ice melts from the outside in (Figure 13).

Traditional external-melt storage devices build ice by circulating cold liquid refrigerant through the heat exchangers. Although this approach is still commonly used in industrial applications, most external-melt systems for HVAC applications currently use glycol secondary coolants for charging. Water surrounding the heat exchanger is both the phase-change material and the heat transfer fluid for the discharge mode.

The charging heat transfer fluid is contained in a separate circuit from the water in the storage tank. Typically, a heat exchanger is installed between the two circuits to allow the same chiller to charge storage and help meet the cooling load directly. Some designs use separate chillers, or two separate evaporators served by the same compressor, to fulfill these functions. It is also possible to simply continue to circulate the heat transfer fluid through the storage heat exchanger to assist in direct cooling, but this approach requires that the refrigeration equipment continuously operate at subfreezing temperatures, incurring substantial capacity and efficiency penalties.

The individual galvanized steel heat exchangers or coils are assembled from a number of separate tubing circuits, and are usually stacked into large, site-fabricated concrete tanks. The tanks operate at atmospheric pressure, and additional measures may be needed to accommodate pressurized systems or elevation differences. The heat exchanger tube cross section can be circular or elliptical. Many different coil lengths, widths, and heights are available to conform to tank dimensions while simplifying coil connections, providing desired flow and pressure drop, and minimizing shipping costs.

Some form of agitation is needed to promote even ice building and melting, although continuous agitation may not be necessary during charging. Agitation is usually provided by distributing compressed air through plastic pipes under each stack of heat exchangers.

The annular thickness of ice formed on the heat exchanger can vary widely, but an average of about 36 mm is typically used in published ratings. Proper ice-making control is particularly important for external melt systems. Ice-making temperatures are driven lower by excessive ice thickness. Because any new ice must form on the surface of existing ice, there is a benefit to limiting the ice thickness to what is needed for the following discharge period, while still ensuring an adequate storage inventory. Also, ice bridging must be prevented. Flow of liquid water must be preserved between adjacent circuits of ice-building coils. Once flow is stopped or restricted, the ability to melt any ice can be significantly limited. Maintaining minimum ice inventory levels discourages ice bridging and promotes efficiency. Ice thickness controllers that sense a change in electrical conductivity are commonly used to control ice building, but other types are available. Manufacturers specify the number and location of thickness controllers. Continuous inventory measurement can be obtained by load cells or strain gages that measure the mass of the ice and steel coils, multiple thickness sensors, or by the change in water level, compensating for compressed air introduced into the tank.

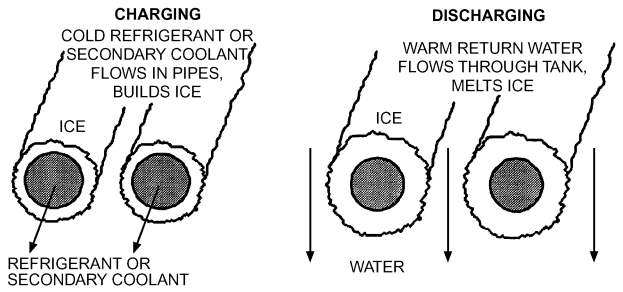

Fig. 13 Charge and Discharge of External-Melt Ice Storage

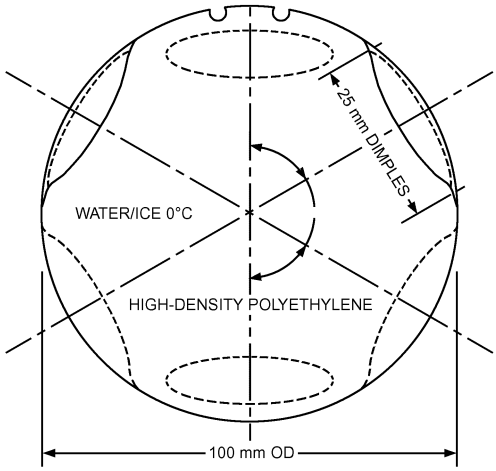

Fig. 14 Encapsulated Ice: Spherical Container

(Courtesy Cryogel)

Because the storage tank is at atmospheric pressure, some method may be needed to connect to a higher-pressure distribution water loop. The simplest methods are locating the tank at the highest elevation or adding a chilled-water heat exchanger. Adding pressure-sustaining valves on the tank return or regenerative turbine pumping are other possibilities.

The wider coil spacing typical of external-melt heat exchangers results in lower ice-making temperatures than in internal-melt systems. However, the direct-contact heat exchange in melting provides consistently low chilled-water temperatures of approximately 1°C and high discharge rate capacity. Separate flow circuits for the chiller and storage provide flexibility in assigning cooling load to each device in any desired proportion.

Encapsulated Ice

Encapsulated storage systems use a phase-change material, usually water, contained in relatively small polymeric vessels. A large number of these primary containers are placed in one or more tanks through which a secondary coolant circulates, alternately freezing and melting the water in the smaller containers. Standard chillers are typically used for ice production.

Currently available shapes are basically spherical and are factory-filled with water and a nucleating agent. The sealed containers are shipped to the installation site, where they are placed into the insulated tank, occupying perhaps 60% of the internal tank volume. There is usually no attempt to position the containers in their most compact configuration, instead relying on simple random packing. Some designs have additional surface features. One product uses a 100 mm diameter sphere with deformable depressions or concave hollows arrayed around the surface (Figure 14). Liquid water fills virtually the entire internal volume with the hollows in a depressed position. As water freezes and expands, the depressions shift from concave to convex. They return to the original shape as the water melts. Besides accommodating water expansion, the variable-volume shape displaces the surrounding coolant. Displaced coolant can be used to measure ice inventory. For pressurized tanks, an additional expansion tank is included for this purpose; atmospheric tanks use the change in the coolant level for the primary tank as an inventory indicator. Other products use a more rigid shape and accommodate water expansion by leaving a void space within the container. Systems with rigid spheres use an energy balance method for inventory determination. Spheres with base diameters of 75 to 100 mm are available. The spheres are buoyant when surrounded by the secondary coolant. A third method uses an internal collapsible chamber in a 137 mm sphere to accommodate expansion.

A wide variety of vertical and horizontal tanks, both pressurized and atmospheric, can be used. Internal headers are designed to distribute flow evenly throughout the storage volume. Some tanks can be completely buried. Atmospheric tanks must have a grid near the top of the tank to prevent flotation of the buoyant water-filled spheres. Although requiring more heat transfer fluid, the large cross sectional flow area results in low pressure drops of approximately 2 to 3 m.

Charging and discharging are similar to internal-melt ice-on-coil systems, using similar secondary coolants (e.g., 25% ethylene glycol/75% water). Flow typically proceeds through the tank from bottom to top. As with internal-melt systems, the temperature of coolant leaving the storage device varies with flow rate, supply temperature, and ice inventory. Because the shape and volume of the storage tanks varies over a wide range, manufacturers often provide performance data on a per-kilowatt-hour basis.

Ice Harvesters

Ice-harvesting systems separate the formation of ice from its storage. Ice is generated by circulating 0°C water from the storage tank over the surfaces of plate or cylindrical evaporators arranged in vertical banks above the storage tank. Ice is typically formed to a thickness between 6 and 10 mm over a 10 to 30 min build cycle. The ice is harvested by a hot-gas defrost cycle, which melts the bond between the ice and the evaporator surface and allows the ice to drop into the storage tank below. Other types of ice harvesters separate ice from the evaporator surface mechanically.

Typically, evaporators are grouped in sections that are defrosted individually so that the heat of rejection from active sections provides the energy for defrost. Tests by Stovall (1991) indicate that, for a four-section plate ice harvester, the total heat of rejection is introduced into the evaporator during the defrost cycle. To maximize efficiency and ice production capacity, harvest time should be kept to a minimum.

Figure 15 shows an ice-harvesting schematic. Chilled water is pumped from the storage tank to the load and returned to the ice generator. A low-pressure recirculation pump is used to provide minimum flow for wetting the evaporator in ice-making mode. This system may be applied to load-leveling or load-shifting applications.

In load-leveling applications, ice is generated and the storage tank charged when there is little or no building load. When a building load is present, the return chilled water flows directly over the evaporator surface, and the ice generator functions either as a chiller or as both an ice generator and a chiller. The defrost cycle is energized if the return water temperature is low enough that the exit water from the evaporator is within a few degrees of freezing. When operated as a chiller only, maximum capacity and efficiency are obtained with minimum water flow and highest entering water temperature. In load-shifting applications, the compressors are turned

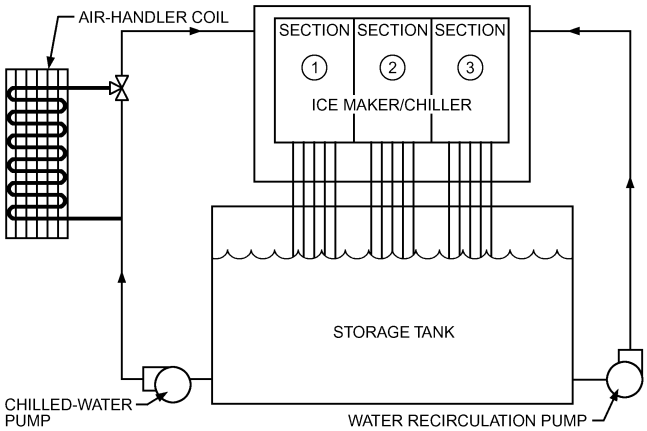

Fig. 15 Ice-Harvesting Schematic

(Courtesy Paul Mueller Company)

off during the utility company's on-peak period, and ice water from the tank is circulated to the building load.

During the first part of the charge cycle, ice floats in the tank with about 10% of its volume above the water, and the water level remains constant. As ice continues to build, the ice comes to rest on the bottom of the tank and builds up above the water level. The ice generation mode is terminated when the ice reaches the high ice level, as determined by a mechanical, optical, or electronic high-level sensor.

Because the ice is free to float in the tank, ice inventory cannot be determined by measuring the water level. Ice inventory may be tracked by maintaining a running energy balance calculation that monitors cooling discharged from and stored in the tank. The amount of cooling discharged can be determined by measuring chilled-water flow rate and supply and return temperatures. Cooling stored in the tank can be measured as the difference between the energy input to the compressor and the heat rejection from the condenser, or estimated based on compressor performance data and operating conditions. Ice inventory may also be tracked by measuring changes in water conductivity as the ice freezes and melts.

Although tank water level cannot be used to indicate the ice inventory during the storage cycle, the water level at the end of charging is a good indicator of system conditions. In systems with no gain or loss of water, the shutdown level should be consistent, and can be used as a back-up to determine when the tank is full for shutdown requirements. Conversely, a change in level at shutdown can indicate a water gain or loss.

Ice harvester systems usually use positive-displacement compressors with saturated suction temperatures usually between –8 and –6°C. The condensing temperature should be kept as low as possible to reduce energy consumption. The minimum allowable condensing temperature depends on the type of refrigeration used and the system's defrost characteristics. Several systems operating with evaporatively cooled condensers have operated with a compressor specific power consumption of 0.26 to 0.28 kW/kW (Knebel 1986, 1988; Knebel and Houston 1989).

Ice-harvesting systems can discharge stored cooling very quickly. Individual ice fragments are characteristically less than 150 by 150 by 6 mm and provide a large surface area per kilowatt-hour of ice stored. When properly wetted, a 24 h charge of ice can be melted in less than 30 min for emergency cooling demands.

Ice harvesters typically use field-built concrete tanks or prefabricated steel tanks. The thermal storage capacity of usable ice that can be stored in a tank depends on its shape, location of the ice entrance to the tank, angle of repose of the ice (between 15 and 30°, depending on the shape of ice fragments), and water level in the tank. If the water level is high, voids occur under the water because of the ice's buoyancy. The ice harvester manufacturer may assist in tank design and piping distribution in the tank. Gute et al. (1995) and Stewart et al. (1995a, 1995b) describe models for determining the amount of ice that can be stored in rectangular tanks and the discharge characteristics of various tank configurations. Dorgan and Elleson (1993) provide further information.

The tank may be completely or partially buried or installed above ground. A minimum of 50 mm of closed-cell insulation should be applied to the external surface. Because shifting ice creates strong dynamic forces, internal insulation should not be used except on the underside of the tank cover, and only very rugged components should be placed inside the tank. Exiting water distribution headers should be constructed of stainless steel or rugged plastic suitable for the cold temperatures encountered. PVC is not an acceptable material because of its extreme brittleness at the ice-water temperature.

As with field-built concrete tanks for other storage applications, close attention to design and construction is important to prevent leakage. An engineer familiar with concrete construction requirements should monitor each pour and check all water stops and pipe seals. Unlined tanks that do not leak can be built. If liners are used, the ice equipment suppliers will provide assistance in determining a suitable type, and the liner should be installed only by a qualified installer trained by the liner manufacturer.

The sizing and location of the ice openings are critical; all framed openings must be verified against the certified drawings before the concrete is poured.

An ice harvester is generally installed by setting in place a prepackaged unit that includes the ice-making surface, refrigerant piping, refrigeration equipment, and, in some cases, heat rejection equipment and prewired controls. To ensure proper ice harvesting, the unit must be properly positioned relative to the ice drop opening. The internal piping is not normally insulated, so the drop opening should extend under the piping so condensate drops directly into the tank. A grating below the piping is desirable. To prevent air or water leakage, gasketing and caulking must be installed in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions. External piping and power and control wiring are required to complete the installation.

Ice Slurry Systems

Ice slurry is a suspension of ice crystals in liquid. An ice slurry system has the advantage of separating production of ice from its storage without the control complexity and efficiency losses associated with the ice harvester's defrost cycle. Slurries also offer the possibility of increased energy transport density by circulating the slurry itself, rather than just the circulating secondary liquid. However, a heat exchanger is usually used to separate the storage tank flow from the cooling load distribution loop. Like harvesters, slurry systems have very high discharge rates and provide coolant consistently close to the phase-change temperature.

In general, the working fluid's liquid state consists of a solvent (water) and a solute such as glycol, sodium chloride, or calcium carbonate. Depending on the specific slurry technology, the initial solute concentration varies from 2% to over 10%, by mass. The solute depresses the freezing point of the water and buffers the production of ice crystals. Slurry generation begins by lowering the temperature of the working fluid to its initial freezing point. Upon further cooling, water begins to freeze out of the solution. As freezing progresses, the concentration of solute increases and the freezing point at which ice crystals are produced decreases. Ice/water slurries have been reported to have a porosity of 0.50 and typical storage densities of 0.0235 m^3/kWh (Gute et al. 1995).

One design uses a 7% solution of propylene glycol that provides an initial freezing temperature of about –2°C. A final freezing point of –4°C indicates that a full charge has been reached and about 50% of the volume has been frozen. Ice is formed near the inside surfaces of multiple cylinders of the orbital rod evaporator. Rotating rods travel along the inner evaporator surfaces, creating an agitated flow that enhances heat transfer and prevents adhesion of ice crystals. The compliant method of connecting the rod prevents damage in the event of evaporator freeze-up. This arrangement reduces or eliminates the need for a defrost cycle, but adds mechanical components. The evaporators are typically arranged in vertical banks above the storage tank, and the slurry can also be pumped into an adjoining tank.

Unitary Thermal Storage Systems

Unitary thermal storage systems (UTSSs) use refrigerant for charging and discharging. The two main components of the system are the storage section and the charging module, which typically houses the refrigeration equipment dedicated to building ice. These components are connected by a refrigerant management system that directs refrigerant flow according to operating mode. During charging, the compressor, expansion device, and condenser fans are active components. Typically, a separate packaged unitary AC system is used to provide facility cooling during the UTSS charging cycle. During discharging, when the UTSS provides cooling, these components are inactive and refrigerant is supplied to a separate evaporator using a small refrigerant pump.

During charging, the UTSS circulates refrigerant through a liquid overfeed heat exchanger submersed in a tank of water. The water remains in the tank. Charging (ice making) and discharging (ice melting) are accomplished by circulating the refrigerant. Ice forms on the heat exchanger in the tank during charging and is melted during the cooling mode. The heat exchanger is typically constructed of copper, and the entire water volume between heat exchanger tubes is frozen. The storage tank is never completely frozen, and a water jacket surrounds the ice at all times.

The ice-making (charging) mode shares the benefits of internal-melt systems. Ice forms directly on the heat exchanger surface and gradually accumulates outward until the charge is complete. Average refrigerant temperatures during charge periods are approximately –3°C. The integral charging module compressor is fully loaded throughout the ice-making period and, once the ice inventory is completely restored, is deactivated until the next required charge cycle.

The UTSS may use both internal and external melt during discharge. These processes are designed to occur in parallel as a self-balancing system, allowing for minimal delivered refrigerant temperature variation throughout the discharge process. These systems also use liquid overfeed evaporator coils to provide facility cooling.

Performance data for UTSS are typically provided by the manufacturer. Published data should include the charge rate for a range of ambient conditions, power requirements for charge and discharge modes, the net usable storage capacity, and the refrigerant temperature at which the net usable storage capacity is delivered.

Other Phase-Change Materials

Water now dominates the market as the storage material for HVAC applications, but industrial or commercial processes sometimes require coolant temperatures that are not possible using plain water. A substantial amount of effort has been invested in the development of materials that would freeze above 0°C and still provide appropriate temperatures in the discharge mode. There are currently no commercially available systems using these materials. Phase-change materials with fusion temperatures above 0°C were usually inorganic salt hydrates that had high anhydrous salt fractions and limited latent heat capacities.

Materials with fusion temperatures below 0°C are more practical to develop and apply. These are often true salt eutectics and typically require lower percentages of the anhydrous components than materials with fusion temperatures above 0°C. Container geometry, or some chemical or mechanical means, prevents eventual stratification of components. Because these materials have salt constituents, they are more corrosive than plain water and are currently only available in encapsulated or all-plastic internal-melt ice-on-coil devices. The latent heat capacities for these materials are usually close to the volumetric heat capacities available from plain water. Supercooling is frequently associated with eutectics and hydrates and appropriate nucleating agents are often added to the material.

Unfortunately, storage at subfreezing temperatures cannot be achieved by adding a freeze depressant, such as ethylene glycol, to water. Unless the additive exists at a eutectic concentration, only the initial freezing point is affected, with the temperature gradually decreasing as the freezing process continues (see the section on Ice Slurry Systems). In most cases, the loss in volumetric heat capacity for a useful range of storage charge and discharge temperatures makes this an impractical solution.

4. HEAT STORAGE TECHNOLOGY

The most common current application of heat storage is in electrically charged, thermally discharged storage devices used for service water heating and space heating. Electric thermal storage has been found to be among the most cost-effective forms of storing electricity from renewable and traditional generation sources (Sandia National Laboratories 2012). Thermal storage systems for space heating can be classified as brick storage heaters (electric thermal storage [ETS] heaters), water storage heaters, or radiant floor heating systems. Other applications include solar space and water heating, and thermally charged water storage tanks.

The choice of storage medium generally depends on the type of heating system. Air heaters use brick as the storage medium, whereas water heaters may use water or a PCM. Combination brick and hydronic systems use brick for the storage medium and transfer the heat to water as needed.

Solar space and water heating systems use rock beds, water tanks, or PCMs to store heat. Various applications are described in Chapter 37; also see Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Thermally charged hot-water storage tanks are similar in design to the cool storage tanks described in the section on Storage of Heat in Cool Storage Units. Many are also used for cooling. Off-peak heating provides utilities a resource to manage electric power and demand while consumers use lower-cost, off-peak electricity to satisfy their heating requirements. Both the utility and the consumer can realize significant savings. On a wholesale basis, off-peak heating may be used to take advantage of discounted (or in some cases negative) wholesale electricity prices. In addition to using off-peak electricity, heat storage systems or ETS provide the ability to store energy from variable renewable generation sources, such as wind or solar, and provide very beneficial grid-balancing services and frequency regulation for utilities. Grid-interactive storage space and water heaters can respond to the needs of a utility on a second-to-second basis by varying their power consumption in response to the needs of the grid. An aggregated group of storage space and water heaters can provide a substantial amount of energy storage and power management to the utility. The cost of grid-interactive thermal storage systems has been found to be among the most affordable and cost effective form of energy storage (Sandia National Laboratories 2012).

Sizing Heat Storage Systems

For electrically charged devices that use a solid mass as the storage medium, equipment size is typically specified by the nominal power rating (to the nearest kilowatt) of the internal heating elements. The nominal storage capacity is taken as the amount of energy supplied during an 8 h charge. For example, a 5 kW heater would have a nominal storage capacity of 144 MJ. If multiple charge/off-peak periods are available during a 24 h period, an alternative method that considers not only the nominal power rating, but also fan discharge rate and storage capacity, yields a more accurate estimate of equipment size. Consult the equipment manufacturer for more information on calculating the capacity of these devices.

A rational design procedure requires an hourly simulation of the design heat load and a known discharge capacity of the storage device. The first criterion for satisfactory performance is that the discharge rate must be no less than the design heating load at any hour. During the off-peak period, energy is added to storage at the rate determined by the connected load of the resistance elements less the design heating load. The second criterion for satisfactory performance is that energy added to storage during one day's off-peak period is sufficient to meet the total load for the entire 24 h.

A simplified procedure is recommended by Hersh et al. (1982) for typical residential designs. For each zone of the building, the design heat loss is calculated in the usual manner and multiplied by the selected sizing factor. The resulting value (rounded to the next kilowatt) is the required storage heater capacity. Sizing factors in the United States range from 2.0 to 2.5 for an 8 h charge period and from 1.6 to 2.0 for a 10 h charge period. If multiple off-peak periods occur during a 24 h period, this method may not accurately reflect equipment sizing. Consult the manufacturer for specific sizing information based on on-peak and off-peak hours available. Figure 16 shows a typical sizing factor selection graph for an application that has a single charging time block per day.

Service Water Heating

The tank-equipped service water heater, which is the standard residential water heater in North America, is a thermal storage device, and some electric utilities provide incentives for off-peak water heating. To meet that requirement, the heater has traditionally been equipped with a control system that is activated by a clock or by a one-way signal directly from the electric utility or power provider to curtail power use during peak demand. More recently, grid-interactive electric thermal storage (GETS) uses two-way communications between the utility and the customer, providing much more flexibility for water heater control. Like heat storage devices, water heaters can provide substantial benefits to electric utilities for storage of renewable energy, to use off-peak power, and to provide regulation and grid-balancing services. An off-peak water heater generally requires a larger tank than a conventional water heater.

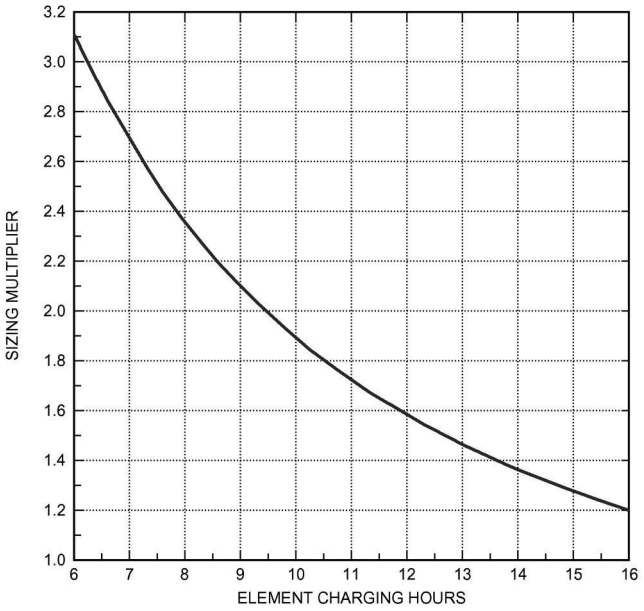

Fig. 16 Representative Sizing Factor Selection Graph for Residential Storage Heaters

An alternative system of off-peak water heating consists of two tanks connected in series, with the hot-water outlet of the first tank supplying water to the second tank (ORNL 1985). This arrangement minimizes mixing of hot and cold water in the second tank. Tests performed on this configuration show that it can supply 80 to 85% of rated capacity at suitable temperatures, compared to 70% for a single-tank configuration. The wiring for the heating elements in the two tanks may have to be modified to accommodate the dual-tank configuration.

Brick Storage (ETS) Heaters

Brick storage heaters (commonly called **electric thermal storage [ETS] heaters**) are electrically charged and store heat during off-peak or preferential times (e.g., when advantageous for grid stabilization or storing excess renewable energy). Heat storage devices can provide substantial benefits to electric utilities for storage of renewable energy, for usage of off-peak power and to provide regulation and grid-balancing services. In these heat storage devices, air circulates through a hot brick cavity and then discharges into the area in which heat is desired. The ceramic brick has a very dense magnetite or magnesite composition. The brick's high density and ability to store heat at a high temperature gives the heater a larger thermal storage capacity. Ceramic brick can be heated to approximately 760°C during off-peak hours by resistance heating elements. Space requirements for brick storage heaters are usually much less than for other heat storage media.

Figure 17 shows the operating characteristics of an electrically charged room storage heater. Curve 1 represents theoretical performance with no discharge. In reality, radiation and convection from the exterior surface of the device continually supplies heat to the room during charging as well. Curve 2 shows this static discharge. When the thermostat calls for heat, the internal fan operates. The resulting faster dynamic discharge corresponds to curves 3 and 4. Because the heating elements of electrically charged room storage heaters are energized only during off-peak or preferential periods, they must store the total daily heating requirement during this period. The dynamic and static charging and discharging rates vary by equipment manufacturer.

The four types of brick storage heaters currently available are room storage heaters (room units), heat pump boosters, central furnaces, and radiant hydronic (brick to water).

Room Storage Heaters (Room Units). Room storage heaters (commonly called room units) have magnetite or magnesite brick cores encased in shallow metal cabinets (Figure 18). The core can be heated to 760°C during off-peak hours by resistance heating elements located throughout the cabinet. Room units are generally small heaters that are placed in a particular area or room. These heaters have well-insulated storage cavities, which help retain the heat in the brick cavity. Although the brick inside the units gets very hot, the outside of the heater is relatively cool, with surface temperatures generally below 80°C. Storage heaters are discharged by natural convection, radiation, and conduction (static heaters) or, more commonly, by a fan. Air flowing through the core is mixed with room air to limit the outlet air temperature to a comfortable range.

Storage capacities range from 49 to 216 MJ (13.5 to 60 kWh). Inputs range from 0.8 to 10.8 kW. In the United States, 120, 208, 240, and 277 V units are commonly available. The 120 V model is useful for heating smaller areas or in geographical areas with moderate heating days. Room storage heaters are used in residential and commercial applications, including motels, hotels, apartments, churches, courthouses, and offices. Systems are used for both new construction and retrofit applications. A common commercial application is replacement of an aging boiler or hot-water heating system.

Operation is relatively simple. When a room thermostat calls for heat, fans in the lower section of the room unit discharge air through the ceramic brick core and into the room. Depending on the charge level of the brick core, a small amount of radiant heat may also be delivered from the surface of the unit. The amount of heat stored in the brick core of the unit can be regulated either manually or automatically in relation to the outdoor temperature or the known or estimated space requirements.

These units fully charge in about 7 h (Figure 19), and can be fully depleted in as little as 5 h. The equipment retains heat for up to 72 h, if it has no fan discharge (Figure 20).

Choosing the appropriate size of room unit(s) depends on the length of the applicable on-peak and off-peak periods, local climate, and heat loss of the area or space. The designer must follow generally accepted practices for calculating design load or heat loss rate to ensure a properly functioning system that delivers satisfactory results. This equipment is generally configured according to one of the following two concepts:

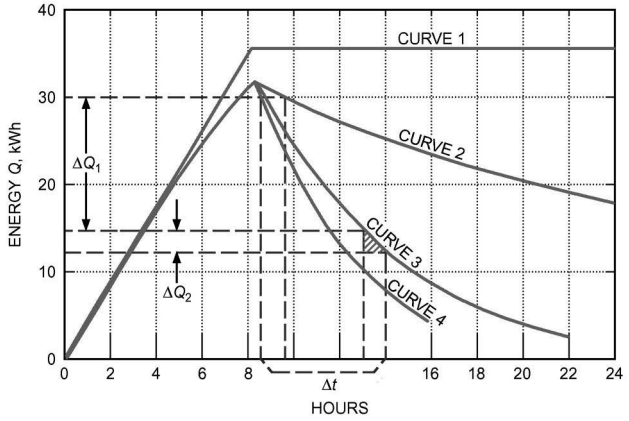

Fig. 17 Typical Storage Heater Performance Characteristics

(Hersh et al. 1982)

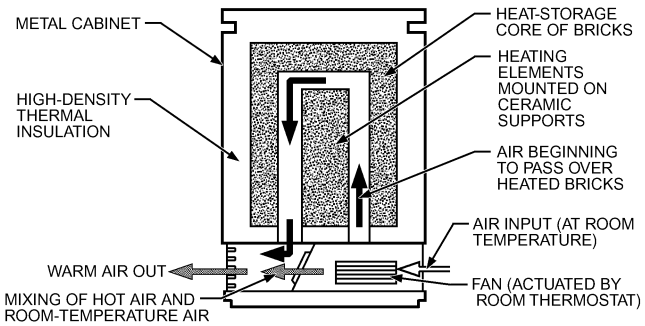

Fig. 18 Room Storage Heater

Whole-House Concept. Under this strategy, room units are placed throughout the home. Units are sized according to a room-by-room heat loss calculation. This method is used in areas with long on-peak periods, generally 12 h or more.

Warm-Room Concept. Under this strategy, one or two room units are used as the primary heating source during on-peak periods. Units are placed in the area most often occupied (main area). Adjacent areas generally are kept cooler and have no operable heating source during the on-peak period; however, some heat migrates from the warmer main area.

When determining the heat loss of the main area, an additional sizing factor of approximately 25% should be added to allow for migration of heat to adjacent areas. Under the warm-room concept, sizing factors vary, depending on the rate structure of the power company and equipment performance under those conditions. Consult the equipment manufacturer for specific sizing information.

The warm-room concept is the most common method used by power companies for their load management and off-peak market-

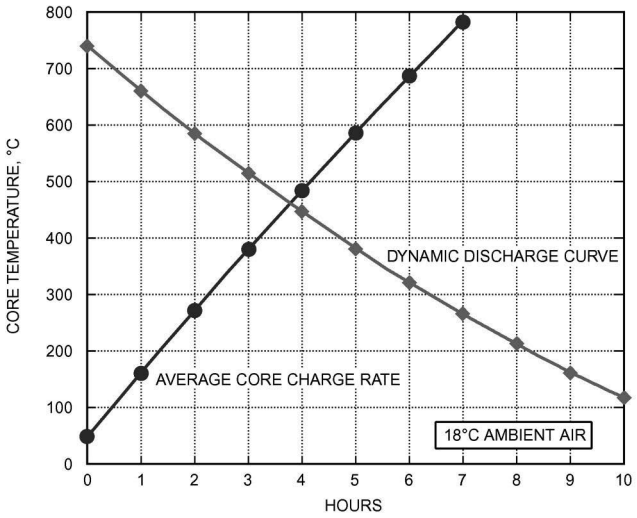

Fig. 19 Room Storage Heater Dynamic Discharge and Charge Curves

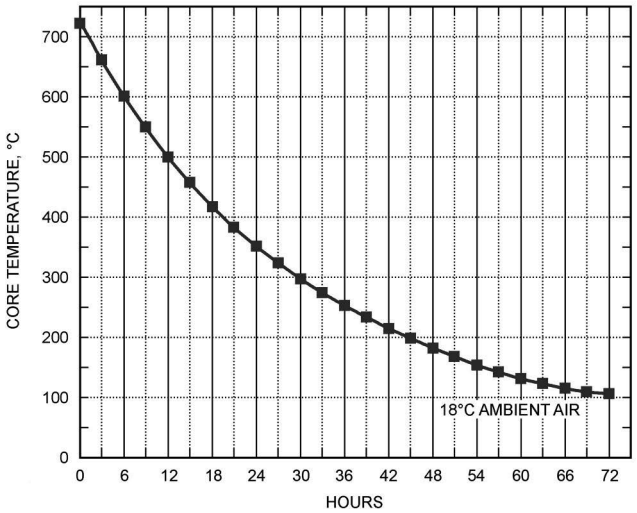

Fig. 20 Static Discharge from Room Storage Heater

ing programs. It is successful in areas that have a small number of consecutive hours of control (generally less than 12 h of on-peak time), or have a midday block of off-peak time during which equipment can recharge. The advantage of this approach is that it requires smaller equipment and fewer heating units than the whole-house concept, thereby reducing system cost.

Heat Pump Boosters. Air-to-air heat pumps generally perform well when outdoor temperatures are relatively warm; however, as the outdoor temperature decreases, efficiency, output capacity, and supply air temperature from a heat pump also decline. When output of the heat pump drops below the heat loss of the structure, supplemental heat, typically from an electric resistance unit, must be added to maintain comfort. To eliminate use of direct electric resistance heat during on-peak periods, storage heaters, such as heat pump boosters (HPBs), can supplement heat pump output. Additionally, the HPB monitors supply air temperatures and adds heat to the supply air as needed to maintain comfortable delivery air temperature at all times. The HPB can also be used as a booster for stand-alone forced-air furnaces or to back up electric or fossil fuel equipment in dual-fuel programs.

Core charging of the HPB is regulated automatically based on outdoor temperature. The brick storage core is well insulated, so radiant or static heat discharge is minimal. Common residential equipment input power ratings range from 14 to 46 kW. Storage capacities range from 310 to 864 MJ (86 to 240 kWh). Larger commercial and industrial sizes have input ratings of 53 to 160 kW and storage capacities of up to 3460 MJ (960 kWh).

Central Furnace. A central storage furnace is a forced-air heat storage product for residential, commercial, and industrial applications. These units are available with input ratings ranging from 14 to 46 kW. Storage capacities range from 310 to 3460 MJ (86 to 960 kWh).

Radiant Hydronic Heaters. A ceramic brick storage system is available that uses an air-to-water heat exchanger to transfer heat from the storage system to a water loop. The off-peak heated water can be used in conventional hot-water systems, including floor warming (radiant floors), hydronic baseboards, hot-water radiators, indirect domestic hot-water heating, etc. An air handler can be added to these systems to achieve hydronic and forced-air heating from the same unit. In commercial and industrial applications, these systems can be used to preheat incoming fresh air in makeup air systems. These units are available in input ratings ranging from 20 to 46 kW with storage capacities from 430 to 865 MJ (120 to 240 kWh).

Pressurized Water Storage Heaters

This storage device consists of an insulated cylindrical steel tank containing immersion electrical resistance elements near the bottom of the tank and a water-to-water heat exchanger near the top (Figure 21). During off-peak periods, the resistance elements are sequentially energized until the storage water reaches a maximum temperature of 138°C, corresponding to 345 kPa (gage). ASME's *Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code* considers such vessels unfired pressure vessels, so they are not required to meet the provisions for fired vessels. The heaters are controlled by a pressure sensor, which minimizes problems that could be caused by unequal temperature distribution. A thermal controller gives high-limit temperature protection. Heat is withdrawn from storage by running service water through the heat exchangers and a tempering device that controls the output temperature to a predetermined level. The storage capacity of the device is the sensible heat of water between 5 K above the desired output water temperature and 138°C. Output water can be used for space heating or service hot water. The water in the storage tank is permanently treated and sealed, requires no makeup, and does not interact with the service water.

In most applications, electrically charged pressurized water storage tanks must be able to be recharged during the off-peak period to meet the full daily heating requirement, while supplying heat to meet the load during the on-peak period. The heat exchanger design allows a constant discharge rate, which does not decrease near the end of the cycle.

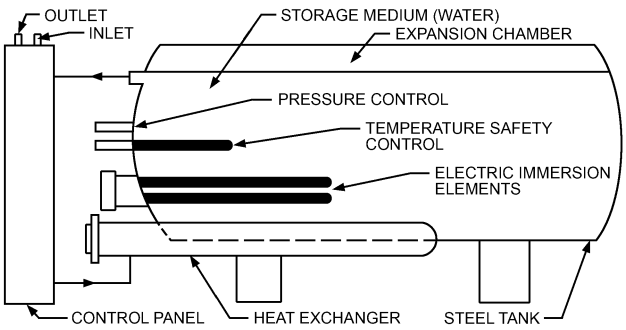

Fig. 21 Pressurized Water Heater

Underfloor Heat Storage

This storage method typically uses electric resistance cables or hydronic tubing buried in a bed of sand 300 to 900 mm below the concrete floor of a building. Underfloor heat storage is suitable for single-story buildings, such as residences, churches, offices, factories, and warehouses. An underfloor storage heater acts as a flywheel. Although the unit is charged only during the nightly off-peak period, it maintains the top of the floor slab at a constant temperature slightly higher than the desired space temperature. Because the cables spread heat in all directions, they do not have to cover the entire slab area. For most buildings, a cable or tube location of 450 mm below the floor elevation is optimum. The sand bed should be insulated along its perimeter with 50 mm of rigid, closed-cell foam insulation, to a depth of 1200 mm (Figure 22). Even with a well-designed and well-constructed underfloor storage, 10% or more of the input heat may be lost to the ground.

Building Mass Thermal Storage

Thermal storage capabilities inherent in the mass of a building structure can have a significant effect on the space temperature as well as on HVAC system performance and operation. Effective use of structural mass for thermal storage reduces building energy con-

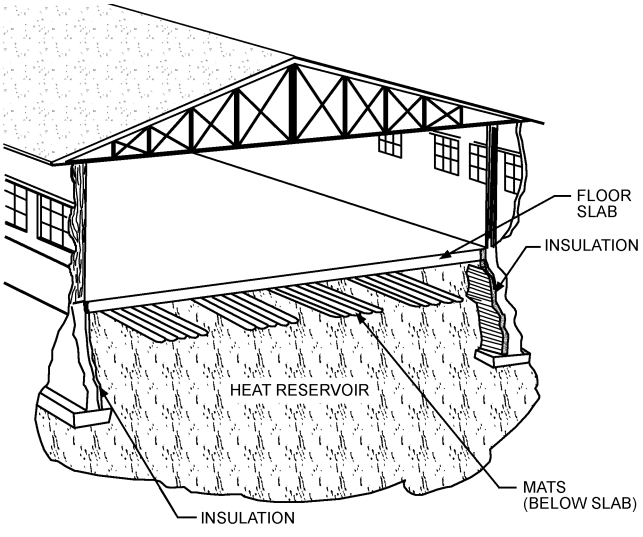

Fig. 22 Underfloor Heat Storage

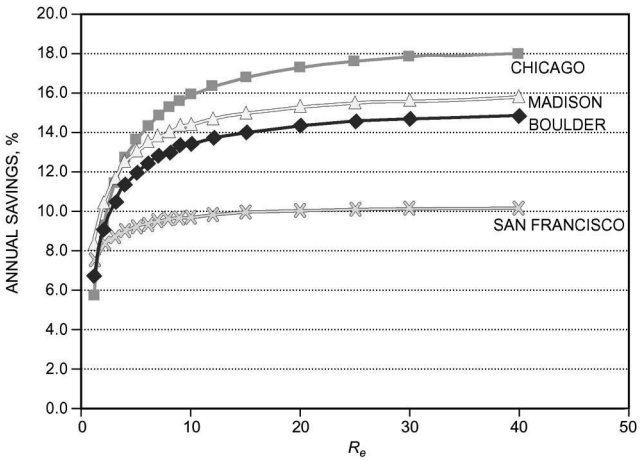

Fig. 23 Annual Energy Cost Savings from Precooling, Relative to Conventional Controls, as Function of R_e

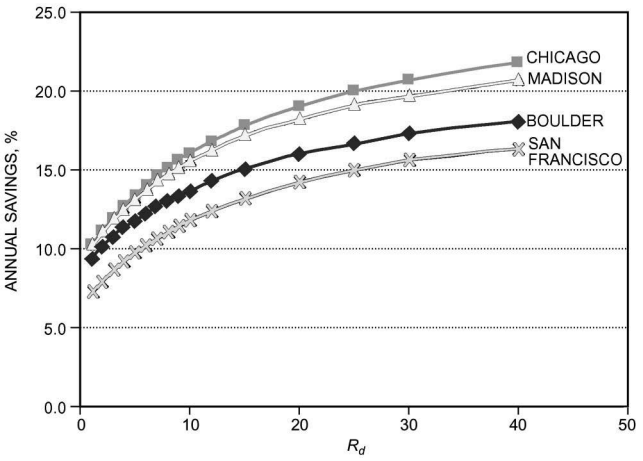

Fig. 24 Annual Energy Cost Savings from Precooling, Relative to Conventional Controls, as Function of R_d

sumption and reduces and delays peak heating and cooling loads (Braun 1990). In some cases, it improves comfort (Morris et al. 1994; Simmonds 1991). Perhaps the best-known use of thermal mass to reduce energy consumption is in buildings that include passive solar techniques (Balcomb 1983).

Cooling energy can be reduced by precooling the structure at night using ventilation air. Andresen and Brandemuehl (1992), Braun (1990), and Ruud et al. (1990) suggested that mechanical precooling of a building can reduce and delay peak cooling demand; Simmonds (1991) suggested that the correct building configuration may even eliminate the need for a cooling plant. Mechanical precooling may require more energy use; however, the reduction in electrical demand costs may give lower overall energy costs. Moreover, the installed capacity of air-conditioning equipment may also be reduced, providing lower installation costs. Braun (2003) provided an overview of related research, and found that (1) there is a tremendous opportunity for reductions in on-peak energy and peak demand, and (2) the savings potential is very sensitive to utility rates, building and plant characteristics, weather conditions, and occupancy schedule.

The potential energy cost savings from precooling depends on the control strategies used to charge and discharge the building thermal mass. Several studies of building precooling controls have been reported (Braun 1990; Braun et al. 2001; Conniff 1991; Keeney and Braun 1996; Morgan and Krarti 2006; Morris et al. 1994; Rabl and Norford 1991; Ruud et al. 1990). Precooling's potential in reducing electric energy costs is generally well documented. Reported investigations have shown that energy costs have been reduced by 10 to 50% under dynamic rates, and on-peak demand reduced by 10 to 35%, just by precooling building thermal mass.

In particular, Morgan and Krarti (2006) performed both simulation analyses and field testing to evaluate various precooling strategies. They found that the energy cost savings associated with precooling thermal mass depend on several factors, including thermal mass level, climate, and utility rate. For time-of-use utility rates, they found that energy cost savings are affected by the ratio of on-peak to off-peak demand charges R_d, as well as ratio of on-peak to off-peak energy charges R_e. Figures 23 and 24 show the variation of the annual energy cost savings from 4 h precooling an office building with heavy mass as a function of R_e and R_d, respectively.

Henze et al. (2004, 2005) and Kintner-Meyer and Emery (1995) evaluated the combined use of both building thermal mass (passive TES) and ice or chilled-water storage tanks (active TES), a load management strategy to shift on-peak building HVAC cooling load to off-peak time. Thermal mass use can be considered incidental and not be considered in the heating or cooling design, or it may be intentional and form an integral part of the design. Effective use of building structural mass for thermal energy storage depends on factors such as (1) physical characteristics of the structure, (2) dynamic nature of the building loads, (3) coupling between the building mass and zone air (Akbari et al. 1986), and (4) strategies for charging and discharging stored thermal energy. Some buildings, such as frame buildings with no interior mass, are inappropriate for this type of thermal storage. Many other physical characteristics of a building or an individual zone, such as carpeting, ceiling plenums, interior partitions, and furnishings, affect the quantity of thermal storage and coupling of the building mass with zone air.

Incidental Thermal Mass Effects. A greater amount of thermal energy is required to bring a room in a more massive building to a suitable condition before occupancy than for a similarly sized less massive building. Therefore, the system must either start conditioning the spaces earlier or operate at a greater-capacity output. During the occupied period, a massive building requires a smaller output, because a larger proportion of heat gains or losses is absorbed by the thermal mass.

Advantage can be taken of these effects if low-cost electrical energy is available during the night and the air-conditioning system can be operated during this period to precool the building mass. This can reduce both the peak electric demand and total energy required during the following day (Braun 1990; Morgan and Krarti 2006), but it may not always be energy efficient.

Intentional Thermal Mass Effects. To make best use of thermal mass, the building should be designed with this objective in mind. Intentional use of thermal mass can be either passive or active. Passive solar heating is a common application that uses the thermal mass of the building to provide warmth outside the sunlit period. This effect is discussed in further detail in Chapter 36 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*. Passive cooling applies the same principles to limit the temperature rise during the day. In some climate zones, the spaces can be naturally ventilated overnight to remove surplus heat from the building mass. This technique works well in moderate climates with a wide diurnal temperature swing and low relative humidity, but it is limited by the lack of control over the cooling rate.

Active systems overcome some of the disadvantages of passive systems by using (1) mechanical power to help heat and cool the building and (2) appropriate controls to limit output during the release or discharge period.

Storage Charging and Discharging. The building mass can be charged (cooled or warmed) either indirectly or directly. Indirect

charging is usually accomplished by heating or cooling either the bounded space or an adjacent void. Almost all passive and some active cooling systems are charged by cooling the space overnight (Arnold 1978). Most indirect active systems charge by ventilating the void beneath a raised floor (Crane 1991; Herman 1980). Where this is an intermediate floor, cooling can be radiated into the space below and convected from the floor void the following day. By varying the rate of ventilation through the floor void, the rate of storage discharge can be controlled. Proprietary floor slabs commonly have hollow cores (Anderson et al. 1979; Willis and Wilkins 1993). The cores are continuous, but when used for thermal storage, they are plugged at each end, and holes are drilled to provide the proper airflow. Charging is carried out by circulating cool or warm air through the hollow cores and exhausting it into the room. Fan discharge air can be controlled by a ducted switching unit that directs air through the slab or directly into the space.

A directly charged slab, used commonly for heating and occasionally for cooling, can be constructed with an embedded hydronic coil. Refer to Chapter 6 for design details. The temperature of the slab is only cycled 2 to 3 K to either side of the daily mean temperature of the slab. Consequently, the technique can use very-low-grade free cooling (approximately 19°C) (Meierhans 1993) or low-grade heat (approximately 28°C) rejected from condensers. In cooling applications, the slab is used as a cool radiant ceiling, and for warming it is usually a heated floor. Little control is necessary because of the small temperature differences and the high heat storage capacity of the slab.

The amount of heat stored in a slab equals the product of mass, specific heat, and temperature rise. The amount of heat available to the space depends on the rate at which heat can be transferred between the slab and the surrounding spaces. The combined radiant/convective heat transfer coefficient is generally quite low; for example, a typical value for room surfaces is 8 $W/(m^2 \cdot K)$.

Design Considerations. Many factors must be considered when an energy source is time dependent. The minimum temperature occurs just before dawn, which may be at the end of the off-peak period, and the optimum charge period may run into the working day. Beginning the charge earlier may be less expensive but also less energy efficient. In addition, energy stored in the building mass is neither isolated nor insulated, so some energy is lost during charging, and the amount of available free energy (cooler outdoor air when suitable and available) varies and must be balanced against the energy cost of mechanical power. As a result, there is a trade-off that varies with time between the amount of free energy that can be stored and the power necessary for charging.

The cooling capacity is, in effect, embedded in the building thermal mass; therefore conventional techniques of assessing the peak load cannot be used. Detailed weather records that show peaks over several 3 to 5 day periods, as well as data on either side of the peaks, should be examined to ensure that (1) the temperature at which the building fabric is assumed to be before the peak period is realistic and (2) the consequences of running with exhausted storage after the peak period are considered. This level of analysis can only be carried out effectively using a dynamic simulation program. Experience has shown that these programs should be used with a degree of caution, and the results should be compared with both experience and intuition.

Factors Favoring Thermal Storage

Thermal storage is particularly attractive in situations where one or more of the following conditions are present:

New Investment in Chiller Plant Required. A key factor favoring thermal storage is whether the owner must invest in a conventional chiller system (new or an expansion) if thermal storage is not used. This typically occurs during (1) new construction, (2) facility expansions, and (3) chiller plant expansions and rehabs.

Thermal storage systems generally require smaller refrigerating equipment than nonstorage systems. Air and water distribution equipment may also be smaller, and electrical primary power distribution requirements may be significantly smaller. In many situations, the reduced cost of this equipment can partially, completely, or more than completely offset the cost of the thermal storage equipment (Andrepont 2005; Andrepont and Rice 2002), and the operating cost benefits of thermal storage are thereby achieved at a lower cost. When expanding an existing plant, the additional loads can often be met by thermal storage at a lower cost than adding new chillers, pumps, cooling towers, and mechanical room space (Andrepont and Kohlenberg 2005).

Peak Load Higher Than Average Load. Because thermal storage systems are generally sized for the average expected load, they can provide significant equipment size reductions and cost savings for applications with high peak load spikes. Buildings such as churches, entertainment and sports facilities, convention centers, and some industrial processes can achieve particular benefits. In addition, most commercial and educational facilities also have load profiles conducive to thermal storage.

Favorable Utility Rates. Utility rates often include on-peak and off-peak schedules. On-peak demand and energy charges are higher than off-peak charges, reflecting the utility company's increased cost of meeting high daytime power demands. Some rate schedules include a ratcheted demand charge, which normally bases the demand charge for the current month on the highest demand incurred during any of the previous 12 months. High demand charges and ratcheted rates, as well as large differences between on-peak and off-peak energy charges, favor the use of cool storage to reduce operating costs.

Real-time pricing structures, which substitute time-varying energy charges for the more prevalent demand/energy structure, are becoming more common. Real-time pricing structures that feature high daily price spikes of relatively short duration also favor the use of cool storage.

Owners with cool storage systems can sometimes negotiate more favorable electric rates from their energy suppliers based on their capability to reduce their electric load during certain peak electric demand periods.

In areas where the electricity supply is limited, thermal storage is attractive because it allows a building to be conditioned with a much lower electrical peak demand.

Utility Payments for Providing Ancillary Services. Fast-responding, grid-interactive thermal storage units can provide regulation services to maintain frequency within desired parameters on the electric grid. ISOs and RTOs provide payments to utilities and aggregators who provide resources, such as grid-interactive thermal storage, that provide this capability.

Back-Up or Redundant Cooling Desirable. Emergency cooling systems are typically provided for Internet and financial data centers, which may consist of thousands of servers densely packed in close proximity. A disruption of electrical power and loss of cooling to such temperature-sensitive equipment can cause a failure in minutes. The availability of back-up thermal storage systems prevents data loss and failure of the equipment. Besides data centers, other applications that may benefit from emergency cooling systems include hospital operating rooms, research laboratories, electrical power generating plant control rooms, emergency command and control centers, manufacturing cleanroom spaces, and specialized museum spaces.

A properly designed thermal storage system can easily be maintained over long periods and discharged quickly when needed.

Thermal storage can provide cooling if the emergency back-up power supply is sized to run just the pumps. Thermal storage can

also reduce the size of a full back-up power supply, because of the reduced power of the thermal storage system compared to a traditional full chiller system. ASHRAE research project RP-1387 (Fenton et al. 2011) provides a design methodology for emergency cooling and demonstrates that, when properly designed, thermal storage is a reliable and cost-effective way to provide cooling for back-up or emergency cooling applications

Thermal storage in combination with conventional chiller(s) can provide a larger portion of the daytime cooling required if one chiller goes down. For example, in a typical traditional system with two chillers, each is sized for 50% of the load. In a thermal storage system with two chillers, with each sized for 25% of the peak load, and thermal storage, if one chiller breaks down there will be 25% capacity from the chiller plus 50% capacity from the thermal storage, for a total of 75% of full capacity. If the chiller remains out of service for an extended period of time, the one chiller can typically recharge more than half the thermal storage so the capacity available is always above 50%. In the nonstorage system, there would only be 50% capacity available.

Cold-Air Distribution Desirable. Cold-air distribution, with supply air temperatures below the traditional 13°C, allows smaller fans and ducts to cool the spaces, and the system can maintain a lower space humidity (Kirkpatrick and Elleson 1997). Consider using thermal storage and cold-air distribution for applications that aim for energy savings, have limited space for fans and ducts, require increased capacity from existing fans and ducts, or require (or could benefit from) lower space relative humidity.

Storage for Fire Protection Beneficial. Chilled-water thermal storage can be configured to provide a fire-protection water supply at a much lower cost than installing separate systems by equipping the storage tank with fire nozzles (Holness 1992; Hussain and Peters 1992; Meckler 1992). Whether water is a critical reserve needs to be determined and communicated to the tank vendor, because this will dictate seismic design requirements for the tank (ASCE risk category IV for essential facilities for fire suppression/emergency use).

Environmental Benefits Sought. Thermal storage can provide environmental benefits related to reduced emissions, reduced source energy use, decreased refrigerant charge, storage of renewable energy, and improved efficiency of the energy supply.

Fast-responding, grid-interactive thermal storage can reduce emissions (CO_2, SO_2, NO_x, etc.) from power plants by up to 70% (Rounds and Peek 2009). Much energy is consumed and wasted when traditional, slow-responding generation sources are used for frequency control and balancing. Regulating with fast-acting, non-carbon-emitting energy storage resources significantly reduces this wasted energy and the associated carbon emissions.

Thermal storage systems can operate with lower energy use than comparable nonstorage systems for several reasons. Cool storage systems benefit from operating chillers at lower condensing temperatures during nighttime operation. Thermal storage provides the opportunity to run a heating or cooling plant at its peak efficiency during 100% of its operating period, for a much higher dynamic operating efficiency. Because equipment in a nonstorage system has to follow the building load profile, the majority of its operation is at part-load conditions, which, for most systems, is much less efficient. Thermal energy storage also enables the practical incorporation of other high-efficiency technologies such as cold-air distribution and nighttime heat recovery. Several facilities have demonstrated site energy reductions with the application of thermal energy storage (Bahnfleth and Joyce 1994; Fiorino 1994; Goss et al. 1996).

Most thermal energy storage systems reduce the size of refrigerating equipment needed. Reduced refrigeration equipment size means less on-site refrigerant usage and lower probability of environmental problems caused by a leak.

In addition to the potential reduction in energy use at the building site, thermal storage systems can reduce source energy use and emissions at the generating plant. Typically, the base-load power generating equipment that generates most off-peak electricity is more efficient and less polluting than the peaking plants that are used to meet high daytime demand. Transmission and distribution losses are also lower when the supply networks are more lightly loaded and when ambient temperatures are lower. Because thermal storage systems shift the site energy use from on-peak to off-peak periods, the total source energy and power plant emissions required to deliver cooling to the facility will be lower (Gansler et al. 2001; Reindl et al. 1995). In addition, by reducing peak demand, thermal storage helps prevent or delay the need to construct additional power generation and transmission equipment.

Thermal storage also has beneficial effects on combined heat and power systems by matching the thermal and electric load profiles.

The U.S. Green Building Council's (USGBC) Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design (LEED®) rating system seeks to encourage sustainable design. The system awards points for various sustainable design features, including reductions in annual energy cost compared to a standard reference building. Thermal storage is a good way for a building to reduce energy cost and comply with the LEED rating system, and has been used in many buildings that have received LEED certification.

Increased Renewable Power Use for Electric Grid Desirable. Renewable power is increasingly used in the electric power grid, and its use is expected to continue to grow. Renewable power generation is often intermittent and largely unpredictable (e.g., wind, solar photovoltaic, concentrating solar thermal), and often is out of phase with the demand for peak electric power. It is not uncommon for wind generation to exceed the required electric load during late evening hours, particularly in winter. As more intermittent (not dispatchable) renewable power is added to the portfolio of power generation systems on the electric grid, challenges will increase for utilities and grid operators to balance the supply of power with customer demands. This creates an increasing need for integrating effective and economical energy storage (ES) into the electric power grid, on the supply side (at generation plants, or on the transmission and distribution grid) and/or the demand side (at electric end-use customer facilities).

Thermal energy storage (TES) is a mature, reliable, and cost-effective type of ES. For example, many large buildings and campuses rely on district cooling systems with electric chillers that operate to meet the cooling loads; these types of systems are one of the major contributors to peak electrical demand, which results in electric grid congestion and high operating costs for building and campus owners. Using TES (which can store significant amounts of energy in the form of cold water or ice), owners of district cooling systems can reduce electricity costs by shifting energy-intensive chiller operation from high-cost on-peak periods to low-cost off-peak periods.

Reindl et al. (2017) found that TES's ability to shift away from high times of electricity usage as well as to match short-term variations in renewable energy production can provide additional value to district cooling system owners and to power utilities. Control strategies can operate electric chillers to charge TES systems during periods of high renewable generation, followed by idling the chillers and discharging the storage to meet building cooling loads during periods of low renewable generation. TES does not depend on the rate of charge, which allows variable-load chillers (charging TES) to follow the instantaneous production from renewable generation sources. These strategies maximize the percentage of chiller energy consumption met by electricity generated from wind, solar, or other intermittent renewable resources. Using these control strategies, TES can boost use of renewable energy resources by as much as 50% and reduce operating costs.

Some thermal storage systems are designed to interact with signals from the utility or organized electrical markets (ISOs and RTOs); these more sophisticated systems are called **grid-interactive electric thermal storage (GETS)**.

Comparative Value of TEC versus Other Energy Storage Technologies

Although ES can use various technologies (e.g., pumped hydroelectric [PH] storage, compressed air energy storage [CAES], electrochemical batteries, mechanical flywheels, hydrogen fuel cells), in multihour storage applications, thermal energy storage (TES) provides superior performance and cost. Reasons include the following:

- TES is among the few ES technologies (along with PH and some batteries) that are fully commercial.
- TES is one of the few ES technologies (along with PH and perhaps CAES) whose central equipment has a 30 year or longer working life expectancy.
- TES has a round-trip energy efficiency higher than that of other ES options, and (for cases of large cool TES) can be near or even slightly greater than 100% when compared to an equivalent cooling system without TES. (This is because TES benefits from better condensing conditions for chiller equipment when recharging at night, as well as from avoiding inefficient, low-part-load operation of chillers and their auxiliary equipment.)
- TES is technically and economically practical across the widest range of storage sizes, with commercial applications ranging in size from a few kilowatts to over 100 MW of equivalent electric power delivered or avoided, and from tens of kilowatt-hours to many hundreds of megawatt-hours of equivalent electric energy stored.
- TES has almost no limitations on siting (other than space for the storage equipment), unlike PH and CAES, which require very specific geophysical characteristics for siting.
- TES is relatively simple and quick to permit and construct, whereas PH and CAES are typically very challenging and lengthy.
- Compared with other ES options, TES has the lowest unit capital cost in terms of cost per kilowatt of equivalent electric power delivered or avoided, and in terms of cost per kilowatt-hour of equivalent electric energy stored (with those unit costs often being lower by an order of magnitude or more, in cases of large cool TES).

Cool TES (e.g., as ice, chilled water, low-temperature fluid) can be used as demand-side storage at customer sites, as well as supply-side storage for turbine inlet cooling of simple cycle and combined cycle gas turbine power plants. Hot TES (e.g., using hot water, hot oil, molten salt, electrically-heated ceramic) can be used as demand-side storage at customer sites, as well as used as supply-side storage at thermal, and especially solar-thermal, power plants.

Electric Power Grid Reliability Desirable. ES critically enhances electric power grid reliability. Different forms of ES are needed for fast response to changes in both power supply and power demand, and for spanning durations ranging from fractions of a second to hours. Grid-interactive electric thermal storage is very effective in providing short- and long-term storage in addition to TES (cooling), which generally is well suited to long-term storage.

Energy Resource Sustainability Desirable. Renewable power generation is one of the linchpins of achieving energy sustainability, but ES is a necessary component of maximizing the integration of wind and solar power into the electric power grid. TES can largely, and most economically, fill that role in terms of multihour ES. Furthermore, only technical solutions that are economical can truly be considered sustainable.

TES can extend the hours of operation and thus improve the economics of using free cooling, whether from cooling towers or from lake- or seawater-based deep cold-water source cooling, thus making these sustainable technologies practical where they might otherwise not be.

Factors Discouraging Thermal Storage

Thermal storage may be difficult to justify economically if

- Cooling load profile is flat, with very little difference between the peak and average loads
- Available utility rates do not differ between peak and off-peak electrical usage
- Space is not available indoors or outdoors for thermal storage tank(s)

Note that even when one or more of these conditions are true, thermal storage may still be justified by the factors favoring thermal storage. In addition, thermal storage should be integrated into the initial cooling system design for it to achieve the greatest economic benefit for the owner and operator.

Typical Applications

Few applications are not suited to thermal storage. Particularly well suited to thermal storage are sports and entertainment facilities, convention centers, churches, airports, schools and universities, military bases, office buildings, and homes, because they have widely varying loads. In addition, using high temperature differentials for chilled-water and air distribution can significantly reduce construction costs, and decrease utility bills.

Health care facilities, data centers, and hotels having loads with only a slight variation between day and night may also be suited for thermal storage. Normally, the thermal storage should be sized to handle the variation in load, not the total load. Thermal storage can provide a steady supply temperature when rapid changes in operating or meeting room temperatures are required. High temperature differentials for chilled-water and air distribution can significantly reduce construction costs, and the lower electrical demand can also reduce the size of emergency back-up generators.

Direct-Expansion (DX) Equipment. Application of thermal storage to unitary direct-expansion equipment is relatively new. UTSS installations can be integrated with DX equipment during new construction or retrofit with existing systems, to provide a distributed energy resource for utilities.

Direct-expansion equipment and the building served can also benefit from thermal storage. Adding storage to DX equipment may improve the combined system's overall efficiency while reducing peak demand and shifting energy use to off-peak periods. Efficiency benefits can come from reduced DX compressor cycling, improved dehumidification, possibly lowered peak rooftop temperatures at which the DX equipment must operate, and DX cooling that is decoupled from daytime ambient temperatures (Willis and Parsonnet 2010).

District Cooling Systems. District cooling systems benefit from thermal storage in several ways. The cost of the distribution system in district cooling applications is a large percentage of the total system cost. As a result, when higher temperature differentials available from thermal storage media are used, life-cycle costs can be lower by using smaller pipes, valves, pumps, heat exchangers, motors, starters, etc. Energy costs of chilled-water distribution are thereby reduced. Thermal storage can provide a steady supply temperature when rapid changes in load occur. The lower electrical demand may reduce the size of emergency back-up generators.

Furthermore, thermal storage may be used to increase the available cooling capacity of an existing chilled-water distribution system by providing cooler supply water. This modification has little effect on the distribution system itself (i.e., pumping and piping) during peak load, because the existing system flow rates and pres-

sure drops do not change. During off-peak cooling load conditions, pumping energy costs can be greatly reduced, because the flow rate can be reduced proportionate to the reduced load.

Most storage tanks are open, so attention should be given to system hydraulics when connecting several plants to a common distribution network where storage tank water levels are at different elevations. Chapter 12 has additional information on district systems and related topics.

Industrial/Process Cooling. Industrial refrigeration and process cooling typically require lower temperatures than environmental air conditioning. Applications such as vegetable hydrocooling, milk cooling, carcass spray-cooling, and storage room dehumidification can use cold water from an ice storage system. Lower temperatures for freezing food, storing frozen food, and so forth can be obtained by using a low-temperature sensible energy storage fluid, a low-temperature hydrated salt PCM charged and discharged by a secondary coolant, or a nonaqueous PCM such as CO_2.

Some of the advantages of cool storage may be particularly important for industrial refrigeration and process cooling applications. Cool storage can provide a steady supply temperature regardless of large, rapid changes in cooling load or return temperature. Charging equipment and discharging pumps can be placed on separate electrical service to economically provide cooling during a power failure or to take advantage of low, interruptible electric rates. Storage tanks can also be oversized to provide water for emergency cooling or fire fighting. Cooling can be extracted very quickly from a thermal storage system to satisfy a very large load and then be recharged slowly, using a small charging system. System design may be simplified when the load profile is determined by production scheduling rather than occupancy and outdoor temperatures.

Combustion Turbine Inlet Air Cooling. Cool storage can increase the capacity and efficiency of combustion turbines by precooling the inlet air. Oil- or gas-fired combustion turbines typically generate full rated output at an inlet air temperature of 15°C, and above rated output below 15°C. At higher inlet air temperatures, the density and thus the mass flow of air is reduced, decreasing the shaft power and fuel efficiency. Capacity and efficiency can be increased by precooling inlet combustion air with chilled-water coils or direct-contact cooling. The optimum inlet air temperature is typically in the range of 5 to 10°C, depending on the turbine model.

On a 38°C summer day, a combustion turbine driving a generator may lose up to 25% of its rated output. This drop in generator output occurs at the most inopportune time, when an electrical utility or industrial user is most in need of the additional electrical output available from combined cycle or peaking turbines. This lost capacity can be regained if the inlet air is artificially cooled (Andrepont 1994; Ebeling et al. 1994; MacCracken 1994; Mackie 1994). Cool storage systems using chilled water or ice are well suited to this application because the cooling is generated and stored during off-peak periods, when demand for the generator output is lower, and the maximum net increase in generator capacity is obtained by turning off the refrigeration compressor during peak demand periods, providing the added generator capacity at the time it is needed most (Andrepont 2001; Cross et al. 1995; Liebendorfer and Andrepont 2005). Some parasitic power is required to operate water pumps to use the stored cooling energy.

Although instantaneous cooling can also be used for inlet air precooling, this refrigeration equipment often uses 25 to 50% of the increased turbine power output. It is especially taxing because the maximum need occurs during times of highest cost for energy and lowest output of the direct cooling compressor, because of the higher ambient temperature. Cool storage systems can meet all or part of the load requirements for inlet air precooling. Evaporative coolers are also a simple and well-established technology for inlet air precooling, but they cannot deliver the low air temperatures available from refrigeration systems. Additional information can be found in Chapter 8 and in Stewart (1999).

Mission-Critical Operations. Thermal storage systems can be used for emergency back-up cooling during unplanned downtime of the chillers that serve mission-critical operations such as data processing centers. Such operations cannot tolerate even short periods of cooling interruptions. If a chiller serving one of these areas unexpectedly goes off-line, it will take at least 20 min to restart the chiller, during which time some kind of back-up cooling is required. Providing emergency back-up cooling with cool storage is typically more economical to install and operate than a redundant air-conditioning system (Fenton et al. 2011).

5. SIZING COOL STORAGE SYSTEMS

A first step in sizing a cool storage system is to determine the amount of the design load to be met from storage. Proper sizing requires calculating a design load profile and determining the required chiller and storage capacity to meet the load profile. For worked examples of system sizing, see the sections on Chilled-Water Thermal Storage Sizing Examples and Latent Cool Storage Technologies.

Sizing Strategies

Cool storage systems can be sized for full or partial storage operation on the design day. A full storage, or load-shifting system, meets the entire design day on-peak cooling load from storage. A partial storage system meets a portion of the design day on-peak cooling load from storage, with the remainder of the load met by operating the chilling equipment. A load-leveling design is a partial storage approach that minimizes equipment size and storage capacity. The system operates with refrigeration equipment running at full capacity for 24 h to meet the design load profile. When the load is less than the chiller output, the excess cooling is stored. When the load exceeds the chiller capacity, the additional requirement is discharged from storage.

Calculating Load Profiles

An accurate calculation of the design load profile is important to the success of a cool storage design, for several reasons, such as the following:

- To determine the amount of storage capacity required, the total integrated cooling load must be known.
- To ensure that the storage capacity is available when it is needed, the timing of the loads must be known.
- To ensure that cool storage suppliers provide equipment with the appropriate performance, the load profile must be specified.

Knowledge of the cooling load is required for each hour of the storage cycle, which, for most systems, is a 24 h design day. A cool storage system based on an erroneous load calculation may be undersized and unable to meet the full load, or it may be oversized and unnecessarily expensive and inefficient. Note, however, that in some cases designers may intentionally specify excess capacity to provide for future load increases.

The shape of the load profile also affects the performance characteristics of storage systems. For example, many cool storage systems respond differently to a constant load than to a load that increases to a peak and then decreases to a lower level. Therefore, it is important to accurately calculate the load for each hour of the storage and discharge cycles to allow designing to the proper total and instantaneous capacities.

Calculating loads for storage systems is similar to that for nonstorage designs, except that all heat gains for the entire design day, on an hourly basis, must be considered.

Select design temperatures with care, based on the allowable number of hours that the load may exceed system capacity. Note that system performance depends on the sequence of weather conditions

as well as the peak daily condition. Colliver et al. (1998) developed design weather profiles for locations across North America, with design weather conditions for one, three, five, and seven consecutive days.

Establish accurate schedules of occupancy, lighting, and equipment use. For example, if equipment, such as computers, operates continuously, heat gains during unoccupied periods are significant. The schedules should account for any changes to occur in the foreseeable future.

Include all sources of heat in the conditioned space. Nearly all electric input to the building, as well as external heat gains from conduction and solar radiation, eventually becomes a load on the cool storage system. Include reheat load when reheat is to be used and include heat gains from the surroundings to the storage tank. Gatley and Ritcher (1985) present detailed lists of often-overlooked heat sources that can significantly affect the load profile.

Consider pulldown loads, which accumulate when systems are shut down during unoccupied periods, and must be met during the first minutes or hours of system operation.

Use the expected relative humidity in the building to calculate latent heat gains from infiltration, especially if supply air temperatures are to be reduced.

Note that there are two types of design days for cool storage applications: the day with the maximum 1 h cooling load for the year, and the day with the maximum integrated load over a 24 h period. In some buildings, these two types of peaks will not occur on the same day. Systems must be sized to provide sufficient cooling capacity on the day with the highest integrated cooling load as well as the day with the highest hourly load.

Recognize that the calculated building load does not represent the chilled-water load on the central plant. To obtain the cooling plant's load profile, the designer must consider the operation of the air and water distribution systems that are used to meet the loads. This analysis should include

- Control sequences for chilled-water coils and space temperatures, including set points and throttling ranges
- Fan and duct heat gains
- Pump and piping heat gains
- Heat gains to the storage system from external conduction to the storage tank

Load calculations for cool storage systems are discussed further by Dorgan and Elleson (1993). General air-conditioning cooling load calculations are discussed in detail in Chapter 18 of the 2021 ASHRAE *Handbook—Fundamentals*.

When cool storage is to be installed in an existing facility, determining loads by direct measurement may be preferable to estimating the loads. Load data may be available from logs collected by the building automation system, from chiller logs maintained by operating personnel, or from on-site measurements made over a period of design or near-design weather conditions. Compare field measurements with reference instruments of known accuracy, energy balance calculations, or some other external verification. Note that, if the load on an existing system exceeds the capacity of the existing equipment, measured loads will be limited by the equipment capacity and may not reflect the actual loads.

Sizing Equipment

Quick sizing formulas are available to estimate the chiller and storage capacities necessary to meet a given load profile. However, accurate evaluation of chiller performance and storage at the appropriate conditions for each hour of the design cooling cycle is required for proper sizing of equipment.

Unlike most air-conditioning and refrigeration equipment, cool storage devices have no sustained, steady-state operating condition at which equipment performance can be characterized using standard parameters. The *usable* storage capacity of a cool storage device may vary appreciably depending on the application (AHRI *Guideline* T).

Usable capacity depends on the load profile and temperature requirements that the cool storage equipment must meet. Net usable capacity is typically not equal to, and in fact is nearly always less than, the nominal capacity. The designer must carry out an hourly analysis to determine the nominal storage capacity and discharging capacity required to meet a given load profile. Hourly analysis is also necessary to specify the thermal performance that cool storage equipment must provide.

Specifications for cool storage equipment must include the operating profile that the equipment is required to meet. (Omitting the operating profile from the cool storage specification is comparable to omitting the design chilled-water and condenser water temperatures from a chiller specification.) The design team must prepare an hourly operating profile to select the appropriate chiller and storage capacities to meet the load. The operating profile defines the system operating conditions each hour of the complete storage cycle. Most cool storage systems are designed for a one-day storage cycle, and the operating profile includes data for a 24 h period.

In addition to determining capacity requirements, designers use the hourly operating profile to

- Develop control sequences
- Define performance requirements that suppliers of storage equipment must meet and against which commissioners must validate actual performance
- Determine requirements for components such as pumps and heat exchangers
- Evaluate system performance after it is installed

The operating profile must include the following information for each hour of the storage cycle:

- Ambient dry- and wet-bulb temperatures
- Total system load
- Load met by chiller(s)
- Load met by storage equipment
- Fluid temperature(s) entering chiller(s)
- Fluid temperature(s) leaving chiller(s)
- Fluid flow rate to chiller(s)
- Fluid temperature(s) entering storage
- Fluid temperature(s) leaving storage
- Fluid flow rate to storage (charging mode)
- Fluid flow rate leaving storage (discharging mode)
- Fluid pressure drop through storage, chiller and piping system
- Total capacity (megajoules) of usable stored cooling
- Maximum cooling capacity or electric demand for chilling equipment

The hourly operating profile should be developed using manufacturers' performance data for specific chiller and storage selections. Typically, designers must iterate between chiller data and storage data to determine the balance between the components. For example, the storage performance characteristics determine the temperatures required to charge storage with a given chiller capacity. Chiller capacity varies with fluid flow rate and temperature entering the evaporator, and with condensing temperature.

The capacity and performance of existing chillers and cooling towers may not be equal to the original ratings, because of fouling or other deterioration. Performance ratings also need to be adjusted to account for the new anticipated operating conditions. Verify capacity of the existing chillers by test before completing the sizing of the storage system.

AHRI *Guideline* T defines the minimum information to be provided by prospective users when specifying performance requirements for cool storage equipment, and the minimum information

to be provided by suppliers about their equipment's thermal performance. The hourly operating profile as described previously includes user-specified data requirements from *Guideline* T, as well as additional information useful for design.

The project specification should require that submittals for cool storage equipment provide all supplier-specified information required by *Guideline* T. The project specification should also require that the equipment be guaranteed to perform as represented by the submittal data when tested according to a specified procedure. Test methods are discussed in ASHRAE *Standard* 150.

The capacity of chilling equipment is an important aspect of sizing a cool storage system. AHRI *Standard* 551/591 allows actual capacities to deviate by approximately ±5% from the manufacturer's ratings. A 5% shortfall in chiller capacity, accumulated over one or more storage cycles, can result in a significant shortage of cooling capacity, which may make it impossible to meet the design cooling loads.

Designers may wish to include a requirement for zero negative capacity tolerance in chiller specifications. Such a requirement should also include provisions for factory testing and certification of the actual chiller's capacity. This may be a consultant- and/or customer-witnessed test. Some designers may elect to include a safety factor of 5 to 10% in the chiller capacity specification. This can be accomplished, for example, by specifying a chiller capable of cooling 105% of the design flow rate at the design temperatures (Dorgan and Elleson 1993).

Judicious use of safety factors is good engineering practice. However, the economics of cool storage are particularly sensitive to misapplication of safety factors. Safety factors should not be used as a substitute for sound engineering principles. The most successful systems are designed with modest safety factors for chiller and storage capacity.

Successful systems are also designed with flexibility to change operating strategies if operating requirements change or if loads increase. In cases with a high probability of increased future loads, designs should include provisions for adding capacity. Operating strategies should, as a minimum, be designed to ensure that excess capacity is used to full advantage, if actual loads are lower than projected. This further reduces operating costs.

6. APPLICATION OF THERMAL STORAGE SYSTEMS

Chilled-Water Storage Systems

Sensible storage may be applied to any cooling load within its application temperature range. Stratified chilled-water storage systems have been successfully applied in hospitals, schools, industrial facilities, campus and district cooling systems, power generation (combustion turbine inlet air cooling), emergency cooling systems, and others. Sensible storage tends to be the most competitive in larger applications (above 38 GJ or over a million litres of storage medium) because of the low cost per megajoule of large storage volumes. However, smaller systems are installed occasionally for various reasons. For example, emergency cooling systems that may be required to discharge for only 10 or 20 min may be quite small relative to typical load-shifting systems. Various thermal storage project delivery methods are possible. Numerous manufacturers produce turnkey storage tanks, and they may team with engineering and construction firms in a design/build relationship. At the other extreme, many systems have been designed successfully by mechanical engineering firms using generic water storage tanks, possibly with the assistance of a specialty consultant to design diffusers and advise on interface design and, possibly, the controls. It is particularly important that the design properly integrate the storage system with the existing system, so the storage system designer must be expert in chilled-water system design generally.

Sensible storage vessels can be connected to chilled-water systems in a variety of ways. One common approach is to associate the storage system with the chilled-water plant so it functions as an alternative source of capacity but has no effect on distribution of flow to end users. Sensible storage can also be located remotely from the chilled-water plant, in which case it functions like a satellite plant. This approach has been used in systems that were experiencing distribution system capacity limitations (Andrepont and Kohlenberg 2005; Borer and Schwartz 2005). Storage can be charged when loads are low, and used to backfeed the distribution system during peak periods. Examples of several Australian systems with satellite storage are described by Bahnfleth et al. (2003b).

A typical inside-the-plant connection scheme for a stratified sensible storage system serving a primary/secondary chilled-water system is shown in Figure 25. As indicated by flow arrows, the direction of flow between the storage tank and the system must reverse between the charge and discharge modes. The storage vessel is connected to the system by a transfer pumping interface, which controls the direction of flow between the tank and the system and accommodates pressure differences between the system and the tank. This is necessary in stratified tanks (typically open to the atmosphere) only when the tank water level is below the highest point in the chilled-water system. Under such conditions, an interface is needed to exchange thermal energy with the system while preventing the elevated system water from draining into the tank and overflowing.

The transfer pumping interface in Figure 26 may have several configurations, the two most common of which are shown in Figures 26 to 29. These figures are schematic. They do not show pump trim items such as check valves and strainers. One pump is shown, but multiple pumps in parallel are used in many systems. Likewise, parallel control valves may be specified in some systems to provide the required rangeability.

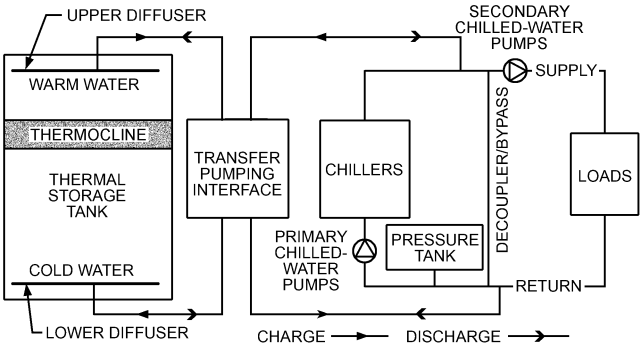

Fig. 25 Typical Sensible Storage Connection Scheme

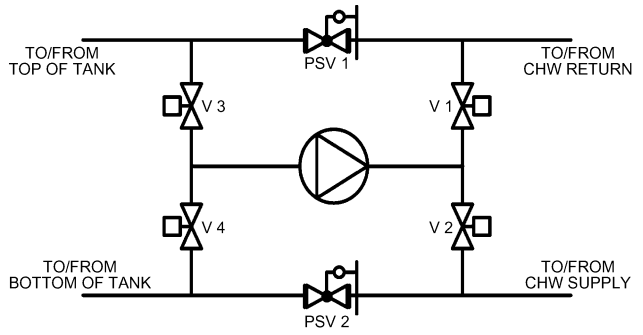

Fig. 26 Direct Transfer Pumping Interface

Figure 26 shows a direct interface, which allows water to flow between the tank and the system while maintaining tank and system pressure levels by using modulating pressure-sustaining valves. The example shown has four two-position valves and two pressure-sustaining valves. It is configured so the pump always pumps out of the tank into the system (i.e., from the lower-pressure zone to the higher-pressure zone). Figure 27 illustrates valve status and flow paths for charge mode. One pair of two-position valves is open and the other pair is closed, and one pressure-sustaining valve modulates and the other is closed. The status of all valves is reversed during discharge mode.

If the water level in the storage tank is at or above the water level in the tallest building or highest air handler or piping run, pressure-sustaining valves are unnecessary. In this case, the only valves required would be to change flow direction when the system is switched from the charge mode to the discharge mode and vice versa. In some cases (see Figure 30), no valves are needed to change the direction of flow.

Figure 28 is an example of an indirect interface that connects the thermal storage system and the chilled-water system through a heat exchanger, which is typically a plate-and-frame heat exchanger with a 1 to 2 K maximum approach temperature. Figure 29 illustrates valve status and flow paths for charge mode. The advantage of this approach over the direct interface is that it eliminates the pressure control problem, and may save pumping energy if there is a large static pressure difference between the tank and the system. However, the added installation and energy cost of this scheme is significant, because of the number of additional components and unavoidable loss of storage capacity caused by the temperature differences (2 to 3 K) across the heat exchanger during charging and discharging. This loss of differential temperature causes a major penalty in pumping energy consumption.

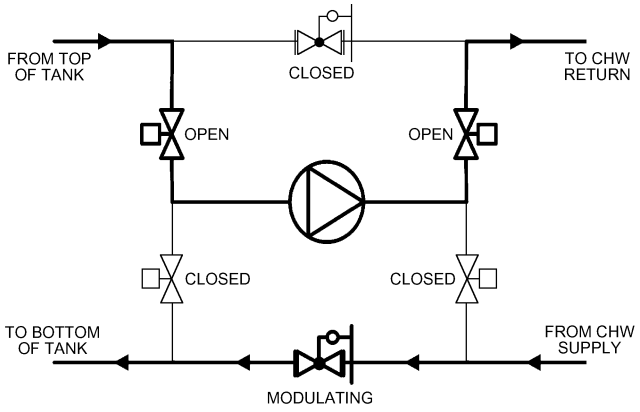

Fig. 27 Charge Mode Status of Direct Transfer Pumping Interface

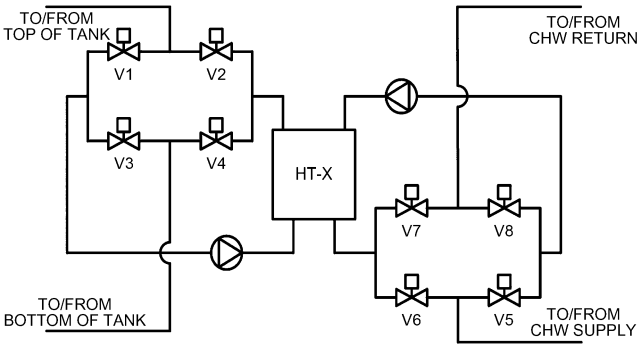

Fig. 28 Indirect Transfer Pumping Interface

For example, suppose that the chilled-water system in Figure 25 has a supply (and charging) temperature of 4°C and a return temperature of 16°C. If the heat exchanger in an indirect interface has a 1 K approach, the temperature of water in the charged tank will be 5.5°C and after complete discharge it will be 14°C. Consequently, the maximum temperature difference to which the storage medium is subjected is 9 K, rather than the 11 K that could be achieved with a direct interface. To have the same capacity as a direct interface system, the tank of the indirect interface system needs to be 25% larger.

Bahnfleth and Kirchner (1999) performed a parametric study of transfer pumping interface economics for direct and indirect interfaces as well as direct interfaces with hydraulic energy recovery. Considering the increased cost of the storage tank to achieve equal storage capacity when an indirect interface is used, this study concluded that, until static pressure differential reaches nears 10 MPa, the life-cycle cost of a direct interface is much more acceptable than for an indirect interface system.

An alternative to the centralized indirect interface shown in Figures 25 and 28 is to isolate loads that are at higher elevation than the tank water level. This may result in lower system cost than a central heat exchanger, and significantly lower pumping energy consumption than a direct interface system. An analysis must be made to determine the total cost and energy consumption of the distributed pump/pressure-sustaining valve approach relative to centrally located valves at the storage tank to ensure that the proper scheme is being specified.

When the thermal storage tank surface can be designed as the high-water level in the system, it can function as the expansion tank and possibly provide a much simpler system design. One particularly attractive arrangement is to use the thermal storage tank as the decoupler in a primary/secondary system, as shown in Figure 30. In this system, if the flow demanded by the secondary pump exceeds the flow provided by the primary pump serving the chiller, the difference is withdrawn from the bottom of the tank and replaced by return water at the top. During charging, any surplus flow available from the chiller after the system load is met enters the bottom of the tank, displacing warm water, which flows from the top of the tank to the chiller.

Figure 30 also represents a possible configuration for a stratified emergency cooling system of the type used in some data centers and other critical loads to cover transitions to emergency systems during an equipment failure. These systems may discharge at a very high rate for only a few minutes. A piping and control configuration that allows stored capacity to be available instantly, without any valve repositioning, is required.

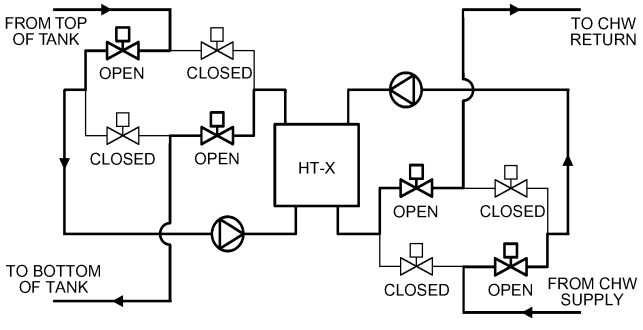

Fig. 29 Charge Mode Status of Indirect Transfer Pumping Interface

Ice (and PCM) Storage Systems

Partial-storage applications present the greatest challenge in allocating the relative contributions of chiller and storage to the cooling load. The goal is to minimize energy cost while preventing premature exhaustion of the storage capacity. Storage devices have a finite total capacity in megajoules (kilowatt-hours) and an instantaneous capacity (kilowatts) that may vary with storage inventory and coolant temperature. Ice storage systems that use secondary coolants incorporate most of the essential design elements, and the following discussion assumes this type of storage system. Note that, even on the design day, there are hours that are less than peak load. A conventional-system chiller would unload during these hours, but partial-storage sizing often takes advantage of the fact that the chiller can be fully loaded throughout the design day, minimizing the investment in equipment and maximizing the efficiency of chiller operation.

On the design day, the operating logic is usually predetermined and obvious. The challenge in maximizing energy and demand savings usually occurs on days with reduced load, which, of course, comprises most of the operating hours. Control schemes can be as simple or as complex as desired, consistent with the utility rate; building load patterns; and the training, experience, and commitment of the system operators. Very effective control schemes have been as straightforward as hot day/mild day/cool day. The chiller is fully loaded on a hot day, half-loaded on a mild day, and off on a cool day. An increased level of complexity might attempt to limit demand for each billing period. There is a minimum chiller demand that can be predicted for any billing period, either by analysis of cooling loads, from experience, or established by a demand ratchet from a previous month.

Because there is no avoidable demand penalty (kilowatts) for chiller operation up to this level, the cost of energy (megajoules [kilowatt-hours]) becomes the dominant influence when lower-load days are addressed. If there is a significant difference in on-peak and off-peak rates, further reduction in the hours of on-peak chiller operation is warranted, if practical. If the rates are approximately equal, chiller operation up to this preestablished limit carries no penalty. In either case, demand savings are maximized. Even more complex methods are available that track storage inventory, cooling load, outdoor conditions, etc., and then modulate chiller loading to maximize savings under specific utility rates. In most cases, simple control schemes are very effective and more long-lasting with the operators.

The three-way storage valve (V1 in Figures 31 to 33) responds to two separate system characteristics: (1) variation in the required contribution from storage as building load ramps up and down and as chiller capacity varies, and (2) the storage system's variable performance.

The temperature of coolant exiting the storage device is a function of flow, inlet temperature, and ice inventory. The temperature-modulating valve automatically compensates for all of these effects, in addition to providing isolation of storage when necessary.

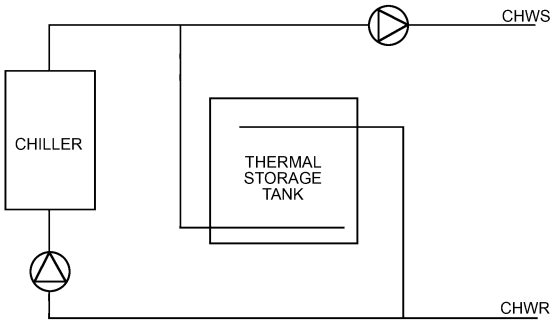

Fig. 30 Primary/Secondary Chilled-Water Plant with Stratified Storage Tank as Decoupler

Ice Making. Each system depicted in Figures 31 to 33 includes a temperature-blending valve (V1) around the storage module. This valve is simply driven to direct all flow through the storage device during the ice-making period. Termination of ice making may be indicated by an inventory measurement or by the attainment of a specific coolant temperature. The chiller is typically fully loaded for the duration of ice making. Once a full charge is reached, further ice-making operation is prevented until the next scheduled ice-making period.

It is often necessary to serve a cooling load during charging mode. The ability to efficiently meet small night loads is a major advantage of storage systems. The temperature of coolant circulating in the primary loop during charge mode is below 0°C and considerably lower than that normally delivered to the secondary load loop. Although a separate chiller operating at a higher temperature can be used to meet night loads, an additional three-way valve (V2) and bypass (shown in Figures 31 to 33) is often placed in the secondary loop so warm return fluid can temper the coolant delivered to the load from the ice-making primary loop. This is critical when pure water load loops are served through a heat exchanger. If a night load is present after charging is completed, valve V1 can be positioned to bypass storage, and the chiller can be operated at standard daytime temperatures. If no night loads (i.e., during ice-making) are anticipated, this valve and bypass can be eliminated, because all daytime temperature control can be accomplished with the chiller or storage three-way valve.

Series Configuration. A common piping scheme is to place the chiller and storage in series. This arrangement provides several advantages. It does not require a change in flow path during charging when both storage and chiller must be in series. A parallel arrangement usually necessitates a change in flow path as the system cycles between charge and discharge. Simple control mechanisms can be used to vary the contribution of each component to the cooling load. All modes of operation (chiller only, ice only, or any ratio of chiller and ice) are easily implemented. Also, the manufacturer may recommend that flow through the storage equipment be in the same direction for charge and discharge. The series arrangement automatically accomplishes this.

Partial storage systems use on-peak chiller capacities that typically vary from 40 to 70% of the peak load. Because it would be difficult to direct full system flow through the smaller chiller and storage at the common 6 to 7 K temperature range, series systems often use a wider differential Δt in supply and return temperatures. Ranges of 8 to 9 K are fairly common, with up to 11 K occasionally used. Flow rates are consequently lowered to levels compatible with the equipment, and pumping energy can be reduced throughout the system. For the series flow examples, 5.6°C supply and 14.4°C return at peak load are assumed.

Series Flow, Chiller Upstream. In the upstream position (Figure 31), the chiller often operates at higher daytime evaporator temperatures than it would in the conventional system, although there may be a negative effect on total storage capacity.

If the maximum on-peak chiller capacity is half of the on-peak load, the chiller reduces the return temperature by half the design Δt, to 10°C at peak load. However, if the chiller leaving chilled-water temperature (LCWT) is simply set to 10°C, the chiller will unload any time the load is less than peak, as the return temperature decreases. This may shift cooling load to storage that should have been served by the chiller, resulting in premature depletion of storage capacity and the inability to meet the cooling load later in the day. Alternatively, by setting the chiller LCWT at 5.6°C, the chiller meets all cooling loads up to its full capacity, before any load is imposed on storage. In some cases, this can be the extent of the discharge control logic. In fact, through simple adjustment of the chiller supply water

temperature set point or chiller demand limits, cooling load can be shifted between chiller and storage in any desired proportion to best exploit the electric rate in response to daily or seasonal load changes. As the load fluctuates and the related chiller contribution varies, the storage three-way modulating valve automatically directs sufficient flow through the storage system to maintain 5.6°C coolant delivered to the load.

Series Flow, Chiller Downstream. Reversing the arrangement retains all of the control flexibility, because the storage modulating valve can be used to manage the relative contributions of storage and chiller (Figure 32). Storage capacity is maximized at the expense of some chiller efficiency, which in many cases is minimal. At peak load, the storage blending valve is set to 10°C, and the chiller will be fully loaded as it further reduces the temperature to 5.6°C. Maintaining this storage temperature set point keeps the chiller fully loaded throughout the day, minimizing use of storage capacity. On cooler days, the storage blended outlet temperature can be reduced. Chiller capacity and electric demand are also reduced. Alternatively, chiller demand limiting can be used and the storage blending valve temperature sensor can be located downstream of the chiller. The storage automatically meets any load in excess of the chiller limit to maintain the desired supply water temperature.

In either the chiller upstream or downstream arrangement, simple temperature control or chiller demand limiting can easily manipulate the cooling loads imposed on either storage or the chiller system.

Parallel Flow. There are times when a parallel flow configuration is preferred, perhaps to address a retrofit application with a fixed-distribution Δt. Chillers in parallel load and unload in response to cooling needs. In storage applications, it is essential that storage is not simultaneously unloaded as the chiller is unloaded.

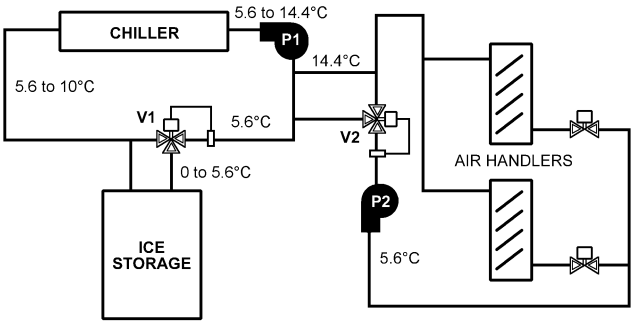

Fig. 31 Series Flow, Chiller Upstream

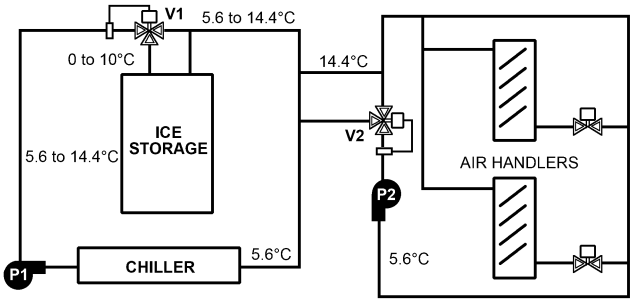

Fig. 32 Series Flow, Chiller Downstream

There are many variations on the parallel flow theme. In the simplified schematic of Figure 33, a two position, three-way valve (V3) at the chiller outlet is included to redirect flow for the charge and discharge modes. This example assumes that the chiller meets 60% of the daytime peak load.

During discharge, in parallel, the same return-temperature fluid enters both the chiller and storage. With no control other than a fixed leaving temperature for both storage and chiller, the contributions of storage and chiller vary in a constant ratio as the return temperature varies. Because even on a design day, the return temperature may be reduced during much of the day, it is apparent that the chiller will unload. If the original selection assumed full capacity from the chiller during all hours, the system would then be undersized.

To avoid this problem, chiller temperature can be allowed to drop to maintain full load, and the storage blending valve sensor can be repositioned to sense the chiller/storage combined flow temperature. Variable-speed pumping of the storage loop is also possible, to maintain a fully loaded chiller at a constant chiller leaving temperature. Storage systems typically have a broad range of acceptable flow rates. Another common alternative is to reposition the return line from the secondary loop to intersect the primary loop between the chiller supply and storage supply. In this way, any low-temperature coolant not required by the secondary loop is returned preferentially to the storage unit, only helping to maintain the chiller at full load.

Further complications arise when chillers are demand limited to optimize utility cost. In a constant-flow chiller loop, the chiller leaving temperature generally rises when the chiller is unloaded, necessitating a drop in storage temperature to compensate. The storage system may not have been selected to operate at the lower temperature. Variable chiller flow can provide a full system Δt at reduced capacity. In any case, it becomes more awkward to optimize load sharing between the chiller and the storage. The best approach, regardless of system configuration, is to calculate flows and temperatures resulting from the proposed control logic at a variety of cooling loads, and ensure that results are consistent with the assumptions made during equipment selection.

A versatile storage design allows the system to shift load between chiller and storage to best exploit the utility rate, thereby optimizing the total utility bill. Accompanying this versatility is the responsibility to ensure that loads are properly shared by chiller and storage under all conditions.

Unitary Thermal Storage Systems (UTSSs)

A UTSS (Figure 34) is typically used in conjunction with a conventional DX system to create a hybrid cooling solution. The DX system provides airflow for cooling from either system. The stand-alone UTSS has two main modes of operation: charging and cooling. During a scheduled utility on-peak period, all or part of

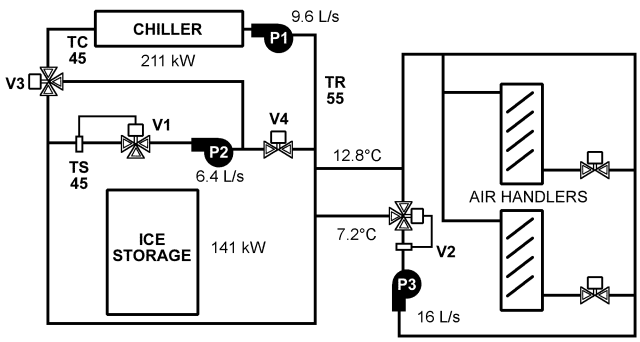

Fig. 33 Parallel Flow for Chiller and Storage

the building load is served by the UTSS using a liquid overfeed evaporator coil inserted in the conventional DX system's airstream. Unitary thermal storage systems are designed to discharge to any degree on a daily basis, supporting full storage, load leveling, demand limiting, and other applications. One configuration, for example, would be for 50% of a 35 kW load to be served on-peak by the UTSS, and the other 50% by the DX system. At all other times, such as during the UTSS charge cycle, the DX system provides all the cooling required.

7. OPERATION AND CONTROL

Thermal storage operation and control is generally more schedule dependent than that of instantaneous systems. Because thermal storage systems separate the generation of heating and cooling from its use, control of each of these functions must be considered individually. Many thermal storage systems also offer the ability to provide heating or cooling either directly or from storage. This flexibility makes it necessary to define how loads will be met at any time under various scenarios.

ASHRAE research project RP-1054 (Dorgan et al. 1999, 2001) developed a framework for describing and characterizing the many methods for controlling thermal storage systems. The methods were defined in terms of the following levels of control:

- Available **operating modes**. A thermal storage operating mode describes which of several possible functions the system is performing at a given time (e.g., charging storage, meeting load directly without storage, meeting load from discharging storage, etc.).
- **Control strategies** used to implement the operating modes. A thermal storage control strategy is the sequence of operating modes implemented under specific conditions of load, weather, season, etc. For example, different control strategies might be implemented on a design day in the summer, a cool day in the summer, and a winter day.
- The **operating strategy** that defines the overall method of control for the thermal storage system to achieve the design intent. The operating strategy provides the logic used to determine when the various operating modes and control strategies are selected. A system designed to minimize on-peak demand uses a different operating strategy than one designed to minimize use of on-peak energy or installed equipment capacity.

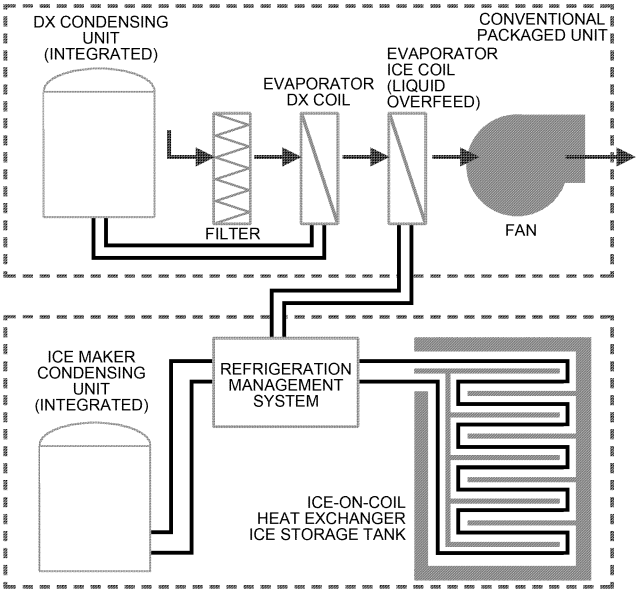

Fig. 34 Typical UTSS with Packaged DX Equipment

(Willis and Parsonnet 2010)

The design of a thermal storage system should include a detailed description of the intended operating strategy and its associated control strategies and operating modes. Dorgan et al. (1999, 2001) provide specific recommendations for documenting each of these elements of operation and control. They also recommend that graphical illustrations be used to describe each operating mode and the logic used to select each mode. The documentation should address control for the complete storage cycle under full- and part-load operation, including variations related to seasonal conditions.

The operating mode, control strategy, and operating strategy framework is useful for describing the operation and control of sophisticated thermal storage systems, and for comparing the operation and control of multiple systems. Many systems use a limited number of operating modes and control strategies. For example, a simple storage system may have a single control strategy with just two modes of operation: charging and discharging (meeting load). Although the complete framework is not necessary to describe the control of such a system, it is still important for the designer to recognize and document how a system is intended to be controlled under all conditions.

Design documentation should also include the basic parameters that helped determine the operating strategy, sizing strategy (full or partial storage), the energy cost structure and the general design intent.

Operating Modes

The five most common thermal storage operating modes are described in Table 5. Operating modes used in each individual thermal storage system design vary. Some systems may use fewer modes; for example, the option to meet a building load while charging may not be available for a specific system design, when there is no cooling load during the time the system is being charged. Many systems operate under only two modes of operation: daytime and nighttime.

Many systems also include additional operating modes, such as

- Charging cool storage from free cooling (hydronic economizer)
- Charging cool storage while recovering condenser heat
- Charging heat storage with recovered condenser heat
- Discharging at distinct supply temperatures
- Discharging in conjunction with various combinations of equipment

In general, the control system selects the current operating mode based on the time of day and day of the week. Other factors that may be considered in this selection include outdoor air temperature, current system load, total facility utility demand at the billing meter, and amount of storage available compared to the storage system capacity. The logic for mode selection is defined as part of the operating strategy.

In some cases, particularly for large cool storage systems with multiple chillers and multiple loads, different operating modes or control strategies may be applied to different parts of the system at one time. For example, one chiller may operate in charging-only mode, while another chiller may operate only to meet a building load.

An operating mode is defined by its control sequence, or sequence of operation. The specified control sequence defines the specifics of what equipment is to be operated, the values of the control system set points, the function of each control valve and other control device, and any other function necessary to achieve the design intent for that operating mode. These all result in a description of individual control loops and their responses to changes in loads or other variables.

Charging Storage with No Load. Control sequences for the storage charging-only mode are generally easily defined. Typically, the generation equipment (e.g., chillers or boilers) operates at full capacity with a constant supply temperature set point and constant

Table 5 Common Thermal Storage Operating Modes

Operating Mode	Heat Storage	Cool Storage
Charging storage	Operating heating equipment to add heat to storage	Operating cooling equipment to remove heat from storage
Charging storage while meeting loads	Operating heating equipment to add heat to storage *and* meet loads	Operating cooling equipment to remove heat from storage *and* meet loads
Meeting loads from storage only	Discharging (removing heat from) storage to meet loads without operating heating equipment	Discharging (adding heat to) storage to meet loads without operating cooling equipment
Meeting loads from storage and direct equipment operation	Discharging (removing heat from) storage *and* operating heating equipment to meet loads	Discharging (adding heat to) storage *and* operating cooling equipment to meet loads
Meeting loads from direct equipment operation only	Operating heating equipment to meet loads (no fluid flow to or from storage)	Operating cooling equipment to meet loads (no fluid flow to or from storage)

flow through the storage system. Charging begins at a specified time and continues until the storage is considered fully charged or the period available for charging has ended. Under this scenario, all equipment designated as being available for charging is operated for storage purposes.

Charging Storage While Meeting the Load. This mode is more complex than the charging-only mode, but is necessary in systems that must meet loads during the charging period, such as in hospitals or data centers. Control sequences for this mode generally operate all designated generation equipment at its maximum capacity. Capacity that is not needed to meet the load is diverted to charging storage. Depending on system design, the load may be piped in series or in parallel with the storage tank. Some systems may have unique requirements in this mode to allow both charging storage and distribution of capacity to meet the load. For example, for an ice storage system using a heat exchanger between a glycol/water mixture and chilled-water loop, the designer may need to address freeze protection on the chilled-water loop side of the heat exchanger.

Meeting Load from Discharging Only. A control sequence for the discharging-only mode (full storage or load shifting) is generally straightforward. The generating equipment is not operated and the entire load is met from the storage system.

Meeting Load from Discharging and Direct Equipment Operation. Control sequences for this mode, used in partial storage operation, must regulate the portion of the load at any time that will be met from storage and the portion that will be met from direct generation. These control sequences are typically more complex, because more variables come into play in selecting what equipment to operate and at which capacity. These sequences have generally been applied to cool storage systems, although they could be equally applied to heat storage systems. The discussion here is based on cool storage applications. There are three common control sequences used for this mode: chiller priority, storage priority, and constant-proportion control. Nearly all partial-storage system sequences can be described (1) by indicating whether chiller-priority, storage-priority, or proportional control is to be used; and (2) by specifying the applicable cooling equipment demand limit and storage system discharge rate limit.

Applicable utility rates and system efficiency in the various operating modes ultimately determine selection of the preferred control sequences. If on-peak energy cost is significantly higher than off-peak energy cost, use of stored energy should be maximized during on-peak period(s), and a storage-priority sequence is appropriate. If on-peak energy cost is not significantly more than off-peak energy cost, a chiller-priority sequence is appropriate. When demand charges are high, some type of demand-limiting control scheme should be implemented.

Chiller-priority control includes operating the chilling equipment, up to the designated available capacity, to meet loads. Cooling loads in excess of this capacity are then met by the storage system. If a demand limit is in place, either on the facility, cooling plant, or individual chilling equipment, the available chilling equipment capacity can be less than the maximum system capacity.

Chiller-priority control can be implemented with any storage configuration; however, it is most commonly applied with the refrigeration equipment in series with and upstream of the storage components. A simple implementation method is to set both the chiller and storage discharge temperature set points equal to the desired system supply water temperature. When the load is less than that available from the cooling equipment, the equipment operates as required to maintain the set point. When the system load exceeds the available cooling equipment capacity, the supply temperature increases above its set point, which requires some flow to be diverted through the storage system to satisfy the load. Note that sensing errors in downstream temperature measurement may cause unintentional use of storage before the available equipment capacity has been fully used. When premature depletion happens, the usable storage capacity is not available when it was intended and originally scheduled, thereby resulting in a demand penalty, which will show up on the utility bill.

Storage-priority control meets the load from storage up to its available maximum discharge rate. When the load exceeds this discharge rate, the cooling equipment must operate to meet the remaining load. A storage-priority control sequence must ensure that the storage system is not depleted prematurely during the discharge cycle. Failure to properly control or limit the maximum discharge rate could result in loss of control of the cooling load, unexpected demand charges, or both. Load forecasting is required to optimize the benefits of this control method. Chapter 43 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications* describes a method for forecasting diurnal energy requirements. Simpler storage-priority control sequences have also been used that include using constant system discharge rates, predetermined system discharge rate schedules, or other load predictive and control methodologies.

Constant-proportion control or **proportional control** sequences divide the load between cooling equipment and storage. The load may be divided equally or in some other specific proportion that can then be changed in response to changing conditions. Limits on the storage system discharge rate or a demand-limiting requirement on the cooling equipment, plant or facility wide, may be applied in determining these proportions.

Demand-limiting control may be applied to any of the aforementioned sequences. This control method attempts to limit facility or cooling plant demand either by setting a maximum capacity above which the cooling equipment cannot operate or by adjusting the cooling equipment discharge temperature set point. Because chiller demand can be a significant portion of overall system demand, large demand savings are possible with this control sequence. The demand limit may be a fixed value or may change in response to predefined changes in specific conditions. Demand limiting is generally most effective when chiller capacity is controlled in response to the total demand for a facility at its billing meter. A simpler approach, which generally results in reduced-demand savings, is to limit chiller capacity based on its electric demand without consideration of the facility's demand.

The storage system discharge rate may also be limited, similar to the approach taken with chiller demand limiting. Such a limit is typically used with storage priority control to ensure that sufficient capacity is available for the entire discharge cycle. The discharge rate limit, which may change with time based on changing conditions, can be defined as the maximum instantaneous cooling

capacity supplied from the storage system. Alternatively, it may be expressed as the maximum discharge flow rate through the storage system or the minimum mixed-fluid temperature in the common discharge of the storage system and the associated bypass.

Operating strategies that continually seek to optimize system operation frequently recalculate the demand and discharge limits during the discharge period.

Control Strategies

A thermal storage **control strategy** is the sequence of operating modes implemented under specific conditions of load, weather, season, power generation resource availability, etc. A **cost control** strategy minimizes electricity costs associated with chiller equipment operation for building space conditioning. For example, a strategy for a summer design day might specify a discharging mode, using storage-priority control during daytime on-peak hours to minimize or eliminate on-peak chiller operation. A winter day control strategy for the same system might use a chiller-priority discharge mode to minimize the storage system operation, because the utility rates are normally close to the same value day and night, thereby negating much of the benefit of thermal storage. Under a cost control strategy, the trigger for operating chilling equipment is often off-peak time-of-use electric rates.

Reindl et al. (2017) provide guidance on a **renewable control** strategy that maximizes the proportion of chilling system electricity consumption available from renewable energy resources. The trigger for operating the chilling equipment is the availability of sufficient renewable power and a need for cooling (either directly to meet the building loads, or for charging the storage system). For example, the chillers operate during peak solar production in the middle of the day, or with wind power generation during off-peak night periods. The chilling system is then idled, and the storage system discharged to cool the buildings during on-peak electricity demand hours (typically in late afternoon and early evening). Thermal storage systems can economically bridge mismatches between intermittent renewable generation and the utility aggregate electricity demand.

Operating Strategies

It is important to distinguish between the operating strategy, which defines the higher-level logic by which the system operates, and the various control strategies, which implement the specific operating modes. The operating strategy outlines the overall method of control of the thermal storage system necessary to meet the design intent. The operating strategy determines the logic that dictates when each operating mode is to be energized, as well as the control strategy that is implemented in each mode.

Dorgan and Elleson (1993) used the term "operating strategy" to refer to full-storage and partial-storage operation. That discussion focused on design-day operation and did not discuss operation under all conditions. For example, a system designed for partial-storage operation on the design day may operate under a full-storage strategy during other times of the year.

Operating strategies that use sophisticated control routines to optimize the use of storage have been investigated (Drees 1994; Henze et al. 2005). The cost savings benefits of such optimal strategies are often small in comparison to well-designed basic strategies that rely on simpler control routines.

Utility Demand Control

Where a utility has incorporated a smart control system into their operations, all thermal storage systems could potentially be used (within their unique operating characteristics) as a distributed energy resource. Specifically, the charge and discharge periods can be moved forward or back to address dynamic demand reduction and energy shift requirements.

Table 6 Recommended Accuracies of Instrumentation for Measurement of Cool Storage Capacity

	Temperature, °C	Temperature Differential, K	Flow Rate, % of reading
Accuracy	±0.17	±0.11	±5%
Precision	±0.11	±0.08	±2%
Resolution	±0.06	±0.06	±0.1%

Notes: *Accuracy* is an instrument's ability to repeatedly indicate the true value of the measured quantity. *Precision* is closeness of agreement among repeated measurements of the same variable. *Resolution* is the smallest repeatable increment in the value of a measured variable that can be accurately measured and reported by an instrument. Values stated are maximum acceptable deviations of sensed and transmitted value from actual value, as measured by a sensor meeting industry standard for testing instrumentation and that is certified periodically to ensure its own accuracy. See Chapter 37 of the 2021 *ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals* for more information on instrumentation and measurement principles.

Instrumentation Requirements

The control system for a thermal storage system must include at least measurement points for the following fluid temperatures:

- Entering and leaving chiller(s)
- Entering and leaving storage
- To and from load

In addition, the system should include the ability to measure flow rates at the chiller(s), storage, and load, as well as electric power to the chiller(s) and auxiliaries. Some method of measuring the current storage inventory is also necessary.

Systems with control strategies that rely on measurement of load and capacity may require higher-quality flow and temperature sensors than those normally provided with HVAC control systems. More accurate instruments are readily available, the cost above standard sensors is nominal compared to the overall cost of the total control system, and the benefits realized are extremely valuable over the life of the system. The accuracy requirements must be included in the specifications to ensure that appropriate instrumentation is provided. Field validation is recommended.

For most applications, the recommended sensor accuracies listed in Table 6 provide an uncertainty of under ±10% in cool storage capacity measurements. When accuracy requirements are critical, the design team should carry out an uncertainty analysis to determine the required accuracy of individual sensors. Note that the accuracy of the system for transmitting and reporting the measured quantities must also be considered. It is not wise to assume that all systems provide the same level of accuracy, regardless of the cost of the system or the components.

If the control system is to be used for performance monitoring, it should be selected for its ability to

- Collect and store required amount of trend log data without interfering with system control functions
- Report averages of measured quantities over a selected interval
- Calculate amount of cooling supplied to or from load, chillers, and storage
- Provide trend log reports in custom formats to fit users' needs
- Provide maximum daily cooling water temperature provided to load, and time of occurrence
- Provide maximum daily water temperature provided from storage to load, and time of occurrence

8. OTHER DESIGN CONSIDERATIONS

Hydronic System Design for Open Systems

For reasons of cost and ease of construction, large ice storage and chilled-water storage tanks are typically vented to the atmosphere. When, as frequently occurs, the fluid level in a storage tank is not the highest point in the system, pumping system design requires

special attention to ensure that the different pressure levels are maintained and the tank does not overflow. The overview of possible transfer pumping interfaces in this chapter identifies the main issues requiring attention in open-system design and some ways they have been successfully addressed in chilled-water storage systems installed to date. The design guide of Gatley and Mackie (1995) provides a comprehensive discussion of open systems.

Cold-Air Distribution

The low cooling supply temperatures available from ice storage and some other cool storage media allow the use of lower supply air temperatures, which permits decreased supply air volume and smaller air distribution equipment. This approach leads to the following benefits:

- **Reduced mechanical system costs**, particularly for fans and ductwork. The cost for electrical distribution to fans may also be reduced.
- **Reduction of 30 to 40% in fan electrical demand and energy consumption.**
- **Reduced space requirement for fans and ductwork.** In some cases, this can reduce the required floor-to-floor height, with significant savings in structural, envelope, and other building systems costs. In this case, if the construction is in an area with strict height limitations, additional floor(s) may be possible, thereby greatly increasing the value of the building.
- **Improved comfort with lower space relative humidity.** Laboratory research (see Chapter 9 of the 2021 ASHRAE *Handbook—Fundamentals*) has shown that people feel cooler and more comfortable at lower relative humidities, and air is judged to be fresher with a more acceptable air quality, as experienced with cold-air distribution systems.
- **Increased cooling capacity for existing distribution systems.** Reducing supply air temperatures can avoid the expense of replacing or supplementing existing air distribution equipment.

The cost reduction enabled by cold-air distribution can make thermal storage systems competitive with nonstorage systems on an initial-cost basis (Landry and Noble 1991; Nelson 2000).

Lower supply temperatures provide greater benefits from reduced size and energy use; however, this technology involves greater departure from standard engineering practice and requires increased attention to condensation control and other critical considerations. Nominal supply air temperatures as low as 5.6°C can be achieved with 2°C fluid, which can be supplied from ice storage; however, 7.2°C supply air is a more efficient target. Supply air temperatures of 9 to 10°C can be achieved with minimal departure from standard practice and still provide significant cost reductions. The optimum supply air temperature should be determined through an analysis of initial and operating costs for the various design options.

The minimum achievable supply air temperature is determined by the chilled-fluid temperature and temperature rise between the cooling plant and terminal units. With ice storage systems, in which the cooling fluid temperature rises during discharge, the design fluid supply temperature should be based on the flow-temperature profiles of the secondary fluid and the characteristics of the selected storage device.

A heat exchanger, which is sometimes required with storage devices that operate at atmospheric pressure or between a secondary coolant and chilled-water system, adds at least 1 K to the final chilled-fluid supply temperature above the generated temperature. The temperature difference between supply fluid entering the cooling coil and air leaving the coil is generally 3 to 5.6 K. A closer approach (smaller temperature differential) can be achieved with more rows or a larger face area on the cooling coil, but extra heat transfer surface to provide a closer approach is often uneconomical. 1.7 K A temperature rise in the air between coil discharge and supply to the space can be assumed for preliminary design analysis. This is from heat gain in the duct between the cooling coil and terminal units. With careful design and adequate insulation, this rise can be reduced to as little as 0.6 K.

For a given supply air volume, the desired face velocity determines the size of the coil. Coil size determines the size of the air-handling unit. A lower face velocity achieves a lower supply air temperature, whereas a higher face velocity results in smaller equipment and lower first costs. Face velocity is limited by the possibility of moisture carryover from the coil. For cold-air distribution, the face velocity should be 1.8 to 2.3 m/s, with an upper limit of 2.8 m/s..

Cold primary air can be tempered with room air or plenum return air using fan-powered mixing boxes or induction boxes. The energy use of fan-powered mixing boxes is significant and negates much of the savings from downsizing central supply fans (Elleson 1993; Hittle and Smith 1994). Diffusers designed with a high ratio of induced room air to supply air can provide supply air directly to the space without drafts, thereby eliminating the need for fan-powered boxes.

If the supply airflow rate to occupied spaces is expected to be below 2 L/(s · m^2), fan-powered or induction boxes should be used to boost the air circulation rate. At supply airflow rates of 2 to 3 L/(s · m^2), use a diffuser with a high ratio of induced room air to supply air to ensure adequate dispersion of ventilation air throughout the space. A diffuser that relies on turbulent mixing rather than induction to temper the primary air may not be effective at this flow rate.

Cold-air distribution systems normally maintain space relative humidity between 30 and 45%, as opposed to the 50 to 60% rh generally maintained by other systems. At this lower relative humidity level, equivalent comfort conditions are provided at a higher dry-bulb temperature. The increased dry-bulb set point generally results in decreased energy consumption.

In most buildings using cold-air distribution, relative humidity is reduced throughout the building. At these low-dew-point conditions, the potential for condensation is no greater than in a higher-humidity space with higher supply air temperatures. However, spaces that may be subject to infiltration of humid outdoor air (e.g., entryways) may need tempered supply air to avoid condensation.

Surfaces of any equipment that may be cooled below the ambient dew point, including air-handling units, ducts, and terminal boxes, should be adequately insulated. All vapor barrier penetrations should be sealed to prevent migration of moisture into the insulation. Prefabricated, insulated round ducts should be insulated externally at joints where internal insulation is not continuous. Access doors should also be well insulated.

Duct leakage is undesirable because it represents cooling capacity that is not being delivered to the conditioned space. In cold-air distribution systems, leaking air can cool nearby surfaces to the point that condensation forms, which can lead to many other problems. Designers should specify acceptable methods of sealing ducts and air-handling units, and establish allowable leakage rates and test procedures. During construction, appropriate supervision and inspection personnel should ensure that these specifications are being followed.

The same indoor air quality considerations must be applied to a cold-air distribution design as for a higher-temperature design. The required volume of outdoor ventilation air is normally the same, although the percentage is higher for cold-air distribution systems, because the total air volume is lower. As with any design, systems serving multiple spaces with different occupant densities may require special attention to ensure adequate outdoor air is delivered to each space.

Designs using reheat should incorporate strategies to reset the supply air temperature at low cooling loads, to avoid increased energy use associated with reheating minimum supply air quantities.

Storage of Heat in Cool Storage Units

Some cool storage installations may be used to provide storage for heating duty and/or heat reclaim. Many commercial buildings have areas that require cooling even during the winter, and the refrigeration plant must, therefore, be in operation year-round. When cool storage is charged during the off-peak period, the rejected heat may be directed to the heating system or to storage rather than to a cooling tower. Depending on building loads, the chilled water or ice could be considered a by-product of heating. One potential use of the heat is to provide morning warm-up on the following day.

Heating, in conjunction with a cool storage system, can be achieved using heat pumps or heat reclaim equipment, such as double-bundle condensers, two condensers in series on the refrigeration side, or a heat exchanger in the condenser water circuit. Cooling is withdrawn from storage as needed; when heat is required, the cool storage is recharged and used as the heat source for the heat pump. If needed, additional heat must be obtained from another source because this type of system can supply usable heating energy only when the heat pump or heat recovery equipment is running. Possible secondary heat sources include a heat storage system, solar collectors, or waste heat recovery from exhaust air. When more cooling than heating is required, excess energy can be rejected through a cooling tower.

Individual storage units may be alternated between heat storage and cool storage service. Stored heat can be used to meet the building's heating requirements, which may include morning warm-up and/or evening heating, and stored cooling can provide midday cooling. If both the chiller and the storage are large enough, all compressor and boiler operation during the on-peak period can be avoided, and the heating or cooling requirements can be satisfied from storage. This method of operation replaces the air-side economizer cycle that uses outdoor air to cool the building when the enthalpy of outdoor air is lower than that of return air.

The extra cost of equipping a chilled-water storage facility for heat storage is small. Necessary plant additions may include a partition in the storage tank to convert a portion to warm-water storage, some additional controls, and a chiller equipped for heat reclaim. The additional cost may be offset by savings in heating energy. In fact, adding heat storage may increase the economic advantage of installing cool storage.

Take care to avoid thermal shock when using cast-in-place concrete tanks. Tamblyn (1985) showed that the seasonal change from heat storage to cool storage caused sizable leaks to develop if the cooldown period was fewer than five days. Raising the temperature of a cast-in-place concrete tank causes no problems because it generates compressive stresses, which concrete can sustain. Cooldown, on the other hand, causes tensile stresses, under which cast-in-place concrete has low strength and, therefore, is more prone to failure. However, precast prestressed concrete tanks are not prone to this type of failure because the walls of the tank are in constant compression from the prestressing wires that are in tension and encircle the exterior of the tank walls.

System Interface

Open Systems. Chilled-water, salt and polymeric PCMs, external-melt ice-on-coil, and ice-harvesting systems are all open (vented to the atmosphere) systems. Draindown of water from the higher-pressure system back into the storage tank(s) must be prevented by isolation valves, pressure-sustaining valves, or heat exchangers. Because of the potential for draindown, the open nature of the system, and the fact that water being pumped may be saturated with air, the construction contractor must follow the piping details carefully to prevent pumping or piping problems.

Closed Systems. Closed systems normally circulate an aqueous secondary coolant (25 to 30% glycol solution) either directly from the storage circuit to the cooling coils or to a heat exchanger interfaced with the chilled-water system. A domestic water makeup system should not be the automatic makeup to the secondary coolant system. An automatic makeup unit that pumps a premixed solution into the system is recommended, along with an alarm signal to the building automation system to indicate makeup operation. The secondary coolant must be an industrial solution (not automotive antifreeze) with inhibitors to protect the steel and copper found in the piping. The water should be deionized; portable deionizers can be rented and the solution can be mixed on site. A calculation, backed up by metering the water as it is charged into the piping system for flushing, is needed to determine the specified concentration. Premixed coolant made with deionized water is also available, and tank truck delivery with direct pumping into the system is recommended on large systems. An accurate estimate of volume is required.

Insulation

Because the chilled-water, secondary coolant, or refrigerant temperatures are generally 6 to 11 K below those found in nonstorage systems, special care must be taken to prevent damage. Although fiberglass or other open-cell insulation is theoretically suitable when supplied with an adequate vapor barrier, experience has shown that its success is highly dependent on workmanship. Therefore, a two-layer, closed-cell material with staggered, carefully sealed joints is recommended. A thickness of 40 to 50 mm is normally adequate to prevent condensation in a normal room. Make provisions to ensure that the relative humidity in the equipment room is less than 80%, either by heating or by cooling and dehumidification.

Pay special attention to pump and heat exchanger insulation covers. Valve stem, gage, and thermometer penetrations and extensions should be carefully sealed and insulated to prevent condensation. PVC covering over all insulation in the mechanical room improves appearance, provides limited protection, and is easily replaced if damaged. Insulation located outdoors should be protected by an aluminum jacket.

9. COST CONSIDERATIONS

Cool storage system operating costs are lower in general than those of nonstorage systems. On-peak demand charges are reduced, and energy use is shifted from expensive on-peak periods to less expensive off-peak times.

Operating cost estimates can be developed to varying levels of detail and accuracy. In some cases, simple estimates based on peak demand savings may be adequate. At the other extreme, an hour-by-hour analysis, including energy consumption of chillers, pumps, and air-handler fans, may be desirable.

In many applications, most of the operating cost savings come from reductions in demand charges. Demand savings for each month of the year are calculated based on estimates or calculations of load variations throughout the year and on knowledge of system control strategies during nonpeak months. It is generally straightforward to calculate annual demand savings by repeating the design-day analysis with appropriate load profiles and rate structures for each month.

For some applications, particularly where there is a large differential between on- and off-peak energy costs, chiller energy savings are significant. For many cool storage designs, pumping energy savings are also important. Added savings in fan energy should also be considered if cold-air distribution is used.

Annual energy savings can be estimated using energy modeling programs. However, programs currently available typically do not model the unique performance characteristics of the various storage technologies. Most programs do not consider the interaction between chiller and storage performance; the effects of chiller-upstream or chiller-downstream configuration; or the performance

impacts of chiller-priority, storage-priority, and demand-limiting control strategies. In some cases, these shortcomings may offset the benefits of performing a detailed computer simulation. Additional information on calculating annual energy use is given in Dorgan and Elleson (1993) and Elleson (1997).

10. MAINTENANCE CONSIDERATIONS

Following the manufacturer's maintenance recommendations is essential to satisfactory long-term operation. These recommendations vary, but their objective is to maintain the refrigeration equipment, refrigeration charge, coolant circulation equipment, ice builder surface, water distribution equipment, water treatment, and controls so they continue to perform at or near the same level as they did when the system was commissioned. The control systems must be kept in calibration, water and heat transfer fluids must be treated regularly, and any valves or pumps must be maintained per manufacturer's instructions. Monitoring ongoing performance against commissioned megajoules per kilowatt of cooling capacity delivered gives a continuing report of the system's dynamic performance.

The heat transfer fluid vendor should be consulted for information on treating the heat transfer fluid. Most heat transfer fluids are supplied with required additives by the manufacturer and require annual analysis.

History of previously constructed systems indicates the importance of careful observance to the following items:

- Start-up in accordance with manufacturer's directions
- Introduction of additives in accordance with manufacturer's directions
- Regular inspections (confined-space entry program should be reviewed and in place): visual periodic electronic monitors and/or divers
- Older systems: as applicable, review for upgrade modifications to (1) diffuser system and (2) control system
- Interior and exterior materials (corrosive and noncorrosive) (piping, fasteners, supports, etc.): check for container wall undercover insulation corrosion; repair damaged insulation
- Appurtenances (vents, ladders, overflows, temperature sensors): all well secured and sensors calibrated
- Electrical systems: well secured and connections secure

Water Treatment

Good planning before filling a thermal-chilled water storage system is of utmost significance in maximizing system longevity and minimizing treatment costs. Water treatment for thermal storage systems is not fundamentally different from that for nonstorage systems, except that there is generally a much greater volume of water to be treated or managed. Because of the very large volume of water involved, changing water chemistry once a system is filled and treated is typically quite demanding, costly, and next to impossible to accomplish in a practical way. Different water supplies are typically not equal in their mineral content and dissolved species, and should be individually evaluated for corrosion, deposit-forming, and biological potentials before a system is ever filled. The sulfate content of water used to fill a system is of particular concern as a potential contributor to microbiologically influenced corrosion (MIC). Although water close to freezing has very low corrosion, treatment is required for biological matter, scale, and corrosion.

Initially, many water treatment representatives felt systems required far more chemical treatment than actually required, evidently because they were considering the open system to contain a large surface area, with an associated large volume of chemical evaporation (which is typically not the case). In developing a treatment plan, it is most important to recognize that whatever is present in the system fill water, along with whatever chemical treatment is added, essentially remains indefinitely. The long-term effect of bioreactive species such as sulfate and organic additives and contaminants, which can enter a system at storage tank venting points, should be considered before a system is filled. Corrosion, mineral precipitation, and biological activity can be minimized but not eliminated. This activity produces suspended solids typically less than 1 μm in size that adhere to surfaces over time. It is important to remove this fine matter.

Additionally, it is important to understand that large thermal chilled-water systems are inherently slow to exhibit change and to respond to changes in their chemical environment. Significant unfavorable change may take months to years to become apparent, and then take even longer to correct. Thus, it is vital to set up reference points throughout a system that are representative of changes in system activity. These reference points should then be routinely sampled to obtain corrosion rate and water property data (pH, metals, total organic carbon [TOC], chemical oxygen demand [COD], inhibitor level, suspended and dissolved solids, etc.) to determine whether an unfavorable condition is developing. It is good practice to update tracking data monthly for the first 1 to 2 years of operation to develop a good reference baseline; quarterly sampling is usually sufficient thereafter.

Ahlgren (1987, 1989) provides details on water treatment for thermal storage systems. For further information, see Chapter 50 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*.

Cleaning. Starting with a clean system at start-up minimizes problems throughout the life of the system. Ahlgren (1987) lists the following major steps in preoperational cleaning:

1. Remove all extraneous loose debris, construction material, trash, and dirt from tanks, piping, filters, etc., before the system is filled. Removing as much dry material as possible prevents transfer to hard-to-reach portions of the system.
2. Flush the fill water pipeline separately to drain. If a new water line has been installed, be sure that rust and debris from it are not washed into the thermal storage system.
3. Fill the system with soft, clean, fresh water. Open all system valves and lines to get thorough, high-velocity recirculation.
4. Add prescribed cleaning chemicals to circulating water. Most cleaners are a blend of alkaline detergents, wetting agents, and dispersants. Be sure cleaning chemical is dissolved and distributed thoroughly so it does not settle out in one part of the system.
5. Circulate cleaning solution for manufacturer's recommended time, frequently 8 to 24 h. Check during recirculation for any plugging of filters, strainers, etc.
6. While water is recirculating at a high rate, open drain valves at the lowest points in the system and drain cleaning solution as rapidly as possible. Draining while under recirculation prevents settling of solids in remote portions of the system.
7. Open and inspect system for thoroughness of cleaning. Refill with water and start rinse recirculation. If significant amounts of contaminants are still present, repeat cleaning and draining procedure until clean.
8. When cleaning has been thoroughly accomplished, refill system with fresh water for recirculation rinse. Drain rinse water and add fresh makeup, repeating the process until all signs of cleaning chemicals have been removed.
9. System is now in a clean, unprotected state. Fill with makeup water and proceed with passivating to develop protective films on all metallic surfaces.

***Caution*:** (1) Water containing any contaminants, detergent, or disinfectant must be drained to an appropriate site. Check with local authorities before draining the system. (2) Water should be treated as soon as possible after cleaning the system. Cleaning removes any protective films from equipment surfaces, leaving them susceptible to corrosion. Especially when there is an extended period between cleaning and system start-up, corrosion and biofouling can become significant problems if water treatment is not initiated promptly.

Open Systems. Water treatment must be given close scrutiny in open systems. Although the evaporation and concentration of solids associated with cooling towers does not occur, the water may be saturated with air, so the corrosion potential is greater than in a closed system. Treatment against algae, scale, and corrosion must be provided. Water treatment must be operational immediately after cleaning. Corrosion coupon assemblies should be included to monitor treatment effectiveness. Water testing and service should be performed at least once a month, preferably weekly immediately following initial start-up, by the water treatment supplier.

Systems open to the atmosphere require periodic applications of a biocide. Potable water is usually of acceptable quality for storage tanks that are filled at the installation site. Where the water is in contact with either a metallic heat exchanger or tank, additional treatment may be needed to regulate pH, chlorides, or other water quality parameters.

Closed Systems. The secondary coolant should be pretreated by the supplier. Perform a complete analysis annually. Check the solution concentration monthly using a refractive indicator. (Automotive-type testers are not suitable.) For normal use, the solution should be good for many years without adding new inhibitors. However, provide for injection of new inhibitors through a shot feeder if recommended by the manufacturer. Carefully consider the need for filtering, whether by including a filtering system or filtering the water or solution before it enters the system. Combination filter/feeders and corrosion coupon assemblies may be needed to monitor the effect of the solution on the copper and steel in the system.

11. COMMISSIONING

Commissioning is a process whereby all of the subsystems and components of the system are incorporated into a whole system that functions according to the design intent. The complete commissioning process, as outlined in ASHRAE *Guideline* 0, begins in the program phase and lasts through training of the building operators and the first year of operation of the building. Commissioning strives for improved communication among parties to the design procedure, providing for clear definition of the functional needs of the HVAC system, and documentation of design criteria, assumptions, and decisions.

Commissioning's goal is to deliver a project that, at the end of construction, is fully functional and meets the owner's needs. Some of the fundamental objectives of the commissioning process are to

- Clearly document the owner's project requirements (OPR)
- Provide documentation tools (basis of design, commissioning plan, design, and construction checklists)
- Help with coordination between parties (owner, engineer, and contractor)
- Accomplish ongoing verification that the engineering and construction achieve the OPR
- Verify that complete O&M manuals are provided to the owner
- Verify that maintenance personnel are properly trained
- Accomplish functional performance tests that document proper operation before owner acceptance

Cool storage systems can especially benefit from commissioning. Some storage systems, particularly partial-storage systems, may have less reserve cooling capacity than nonstorage systems. A nonstorage system has excess capacity in every hour that is not a design hour. Storage systems benefit from the use of stored cooling to achieve a closer match of total capacity to total load. These benefits are achieved at the price of some additional complexity to control the inventory of stored cooling, and a reduced safety factor. Therefore, there is a need for increased care in design, installation, and operation, which the commissioning process helps to ensure.

Commissioning should also provide documentation of actual system capacities, which allows control strategies to be optimized to take full advantage of system capabilities.

Additional information on the commissioning process is given in Chapter 44 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*, and detailed information on commissioning and performance testing for cool storage systems is provided in ASHRAE *Guideline* 0 and *Standard* 150, and by Elleson (1997) and Hyman (2011).

Statement of Design Intent

The statement of design intent defines in detail the performance requirements of the cool storage system. It is the master reference document that shapes all future work and is the benchmark by which success of the project is judged. The process of defining the design intent should begin as early as possible in the program phase, and continue throughout the design phase.

The initial statement of design intent is prepared from information developed in the owner's program and the results of the feasibility study. It describes the facility's functional needs, as well as the owner's requirements for environmental control and system performance. These items include

- Required thermal storage capacity (often measured in kilowatt-hours)
- Design chilled-water Δt for chilled-water storage
- Temperature and relative humidity requirements
- Cooling load parameters
- Acceptable hours (if any) that loads may exceed system capacity
- Occupancy schedules
- Reliability or redundancy requirements
- Needs for operational flexibility
- Financial criteria
- Energy performance criteria
- Demand shift

During the design phase, the following items are added:

- Narrative description of the system
- Performance goals for energy consumption and electric demand
- Hourly operating profile for design day and minimum-load day
- Schematic diagram of piping system, including cool storage system
- Description of control strategies for all possible modes and conditions

As the design develops, these items are refined and expanded, so the final statement of design intent provides a detailed description of the intended configuration, operation, and control of the system.

Commissioning Specification

The commissioning specification defines the contractual relationships by which the final system is brought into conformance with the design intent. It delineates the responsibilities of each party; specifies the requirements for construction observation, start-up, and acceptance testing; and defines the criteria by which the performance of the system is evaluated.

ASHRAE *Guideline* 0 provides additional details on and a sample of a commissioning specification.

Required Information

Certain system-specific design information must be assembled before running performance tests. These data are required to determine the test conditions and requirements for a specific system. The following information must be supplied:

- Load profile against which storage device or system is to be tested
- Tests to be performed; users may elect to perform one or more individual tests
- Boundary of system or portion of system to be tested by system capacity test
- Components with energy inputs to be included in system efficiency test
- System parameters, such as

- Maximum usable discharge temperature
- Maximum usable cooling supply temperature
- Criteria for determining fully charged and fully discharged conditions
- Maximum amount of time available for charging storage

Much of this information is normally defined in the statement of design intent.

Performance Verification

Before performance testing, verification should confirm that each component has been installed properly and that all individual components, equipment, and systems actually function in accordance with the contract documents and with the manufacturers' specifications. This verification should include items such as the following:

- Chillers maintain correct set points for each operating mode.
- Chiller capacity is within specified tolerances.
- Pumps, valves, and chillers sequence correctly in each operating mode and when changing between modes.
- Glycol concentration is as specified.
- Storage tank inlet and outlet temperatures are correct during both charging and discharging modes.
- Controllers and control valves and dampers maintain temperature set points.
- Flow switches function correctly.
- Flow rates are as reported in testing, adjusting, and balancing (TAB) report.
- Flow meters and temperature sensors report accurate measurements.
- Pressure-sustaining valve maintains correct pressure.
- Heat exchangers provide and maintain specified differential temperatures.
- Freeze protection sequence operates correctly.

Functional performance testing demonstrates that performance of the system as a whole satisfies the statement of design intent and contract documents. It also determines whether all components of the system function together, as designed, to meet the cooling load while satisfying the targets for electric demand and energy consumption. Functional performance testing is intended to answer basic questions such as the following:

- Does system function according to statement of design intent?
- Does system meet each hour's instantaneous load, at required fluid temperature?
- What is usable storage capacity of the storage tanks?
- What is available system capacity to meet the load, instantaneous and average for the day?
- What is system's efficiency in meeting the load, instantaneous and average for the day?
- What is daily tank standby loss?
- What is chiller capacity in charge mode and in direct cooling mode?

Functional performance testing also helps establish the final operating set points for control parameters such as chiller demand limit, ice-making cutout temperature, etc.

Because the performance of a cool storage system depends on the load to which it is subjected, the system must be tested with a design cooling load profile, or an equivalent profile.

ASHRAE *Standard* 150 provides detailed test methods for accurately determining a system's ability to meet a given cooling load. The standard requires some documentation before a performance test is carried out, including the design load profile, criteria for determining the fully charged and fully discharged conditions, and a schematic diagram of the system illustrating intended measuring points. This standard defines procedures for determining the charge and discharge capacities of a storage device and the total capacity and efficiency of the entire system. The starting and ending points for the performance tests are defined in terms of two distinctive states of charge: fully charged and fully discharged.

The **fully charged** condition is the state at which, according to the design, no more heat is to be removed from the tank. This state is generally reached when the control system stops the charge cycle as part of its normal control sequence, or when the maximum allowable charging period has elapsed.

The **fully discharged** condition is the state at which no more usable cooling capacity can be recovered from the tank. This condition is reached when the fluid temperature leaving the tank rises above the maximum usable chilled-water supply temperature.

Performance testing of cool storage systems tends to be more susceptible to sensor errors than testing of nonstorage systems, because data must be collected and accumulated over an extended time. Sensor accuracy should be verified in the field, particularly when the results of performance tests will have contractual or financial implications. Elleson et al. (2002) discuss verifying sensor accuracy.

Sample Commissioning Plan Outline for Chilled-Water Plants with Thermal Storage Systems

The following is an outline of a generic commissioning plan for cool storage systems.

A. Identify owner project requirements (OPR).
   1. Site objectives.
   2. Functional uses and operational capabilities.
   3. Indoor environmental requirements.
   4. Environmental and utility cost, and energy and demand savings goals.
   5. Level of control desired.
   6. Training expectations.
   7. Expected/current capabilities of owner's operation and maintenance (O&M) staff.
   8. Include specific measurement performance criteria, such as discharge rate, daily cooling capacity available from storage, capacity shifted from peak to off-peak, and average daily plant performance (be explicit as to what equipment is to be included).
   9. If project is a retrofit, identify current systems and their operating schedules.

B. Identify economic assumptions; perform economic feasibility analysis.
C. Identify approximate schedule of operation.
D. Define expected scope of commissioning services, systems, and equipment included, as well as commissioning team members.
E. Conduct commissioning kick-off meeting: establish schedule for future meeting; discuss how performance criteria are to be verified, monitored, and maintained.
F. Develop design intent document (OPR).
G. Conduct design review: focus on adherence to OPR, and efficacy of design parameters, including design load profile, clarity of control sequence descriptions, and maintainability of design.
H. Develop/review commissioning related specifications: include project-specific training requirements and required programming of operational block trends.
I. Conduct prebid meeting: identify commissioning requirements and expectations with potential bidders.
J. Review submittal for adherence to specification and OPR.
K. Negotiate desired exceptions to specification.
L. Prepare site specific checks and test procedures. Potential checks and tests to consider include
   1. Verify proper placement and calibration of critical sensors.
   2. Verify proper setup of valve and damper actuators.

3. Verify proper programming of schedules, set points, key sequences of control, and graphics. Verify proper implementation of sensor calibration parameters and proportional integral derivative (PID) loop tuning parameters.
4. Verify communication speeds, system response times, and maximum trending capability.
5. Use operational trends to verify proper operation of economizers, set points, schedules, and staging.
6. Specialized checks and tests include
   - Verify proper concentration of secondary coolant
   - Restart after power outage
   - Chiller capacity
   - Cooling capacity available from storage
   - Daily plant performance

M. Review operational block trend data. Program new trends as necessary. Conduct installation checks and functional testing. Develop summary of activities and key findings in problem log format. Discuss results with client and contractor. After contractor has made necessary corrections, review corrections and retest as necessary. Note that costs for retesting should be obligation of contractor.
N. Review as-builts and O&M documentation: be sure that clear operating plan is developed and available to operating staff.
O. Conduct/participate in/verify/document facilities staff and user training.
P. Prepare commissioning report: identify unresolved issues.
Q. Prepare systems manual.
R. Complete off-season testing and update systems manual with relevant operation and maintenance information as required.
S. Conduct one-year warranty review.
T. Conduct project wrap-up meeting. Finalize accountability requirements for maintaining performance.

12. GOOD PRACTICES

Elleson (1997) explored factors determining the success of cool storage systems and identified the following actions that contribute to successful systems:

- Calculating an accurate load profile
- Using an hourly operating profile to size and select equipment
- Developing a detailed description of the control strategy
- Producing a schematic diagram
- Producing a statement of design intent
- Using safety factors with care
- Planning for performance monitoring
- Producing complete design documents
- Retaining an experienced cool storage engineer to review the design before bidding the project

A number of pitfalls were also identified that can jeopardize success:

- Owner not willing to commit resources to support high-quality design process
- Owner does not identify and communicate all requirements for cooling system early in project
- Economic value of project not presented in appropriate financial terms; project goes unfunded
- Project justified on basis of incomplete or inaccurate feasibility study
- Assumptions made in feasibility study not documented and not verified in design phase
- Design intent for system not updated as design progresses, or recorded in contract documents
- System design based on estimates and assumptions rather than on engineering analysis
- Design not reviewed by qualified, independent reviewer
- Complete description of intended control strategies is not included in specifications
- Performance testing not required in contract documents, or test requirements not adequately defined
- Equipment submittals not reviewed for required conformance with specifications, or inadequate equipment substituted to reduce costs
- Operation and maintenance personnel not included in design process, or operator training is neglected
- Owner not willing to complete acceptable level of commissioning before accepting system for day-to-day use
- Owner not willing to support qualified, well-trained staff to achieve optimum performance

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CHAPTER 51

DEDICATED OUTDOOR AIR SYSTEMS

Applications 51.1
Air Distribution 51.3
Equipment Configurations 51.4
Control 51.6

DEDICATED outdoor air systems (DOASs) use separate equipment to condition all of the outdoor air brought into a building for ventilation, and deliver it to each occupied space, either directly or in conjunction with local or central HVAC units serving those same spaces. The local or central HVAC units are used to maintain space temperature. Figure 1 shows a typical DOAS configuration for a large retail store. A DOAS unit can be simple, with just a few components (e.g., a fan and a cooling coil), or more complex, with several energy recovery devices, cooling coils, solid or liquid desiccant devices, heating coils, and one or more fans. Generally, the objective of a DOAS is to condition incoming outdoor air before it mixes (and is diluted) with the remainder of the building air so that it is easier to dehumidify and clean, and so that energy in outgoing air can be recovered to precondition incoming outdoor air. For more detailed information, see the *ASHRAE Design Guide for Dedicated Outdoor Air Systems* (Morner et al. 2022).

1. APPLICATIONS

A DOAS can be effectively incorporated into nearly any commercial, institutional, industrial, or multifamily building. Although all building types can benefit from DOAS, those with strict requirements for indoor air quality, ventilation, humidity, or energy efficiency make particularly good candidates. As the amount of outdoor air rises in proportion to recirculated return air, DOAS benefits rise accordingly. Examples of particularly good candidates include

- Buildings in humid climates
- Facilities that require more than minimum code-required ventilation rates (e.g., hospitals, laboratories, others that handle pollutants that should not be recirculated to other spaces)

Facilities using DOAS also typically benefit from the use of energy recovery. Other common drivers are (1) improving indoor humidity control, (2) reducing energy use, (3) simplifying ventilation system design and control, (4) the desire to use heating and cooling equipment that does not provide ventilation and/or dehumidification (e.g., radiant panels, chilled beams, sensible-cooling terminals), and (5) reducing installation cost.

1.1 HUMIDITY CONTROL

In many locations, for both residential and commercial buildings, mechanical ventilation is either a code requirement or an industry standard practice. Introducing outdoor air often increases dehumidification loads: incoming outdoor or makeup air typically carries more than 80% of a building's annual dehumidification load (see the section on HVAC Systems in Chapter 64 of the 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook—HVAC Applications*).

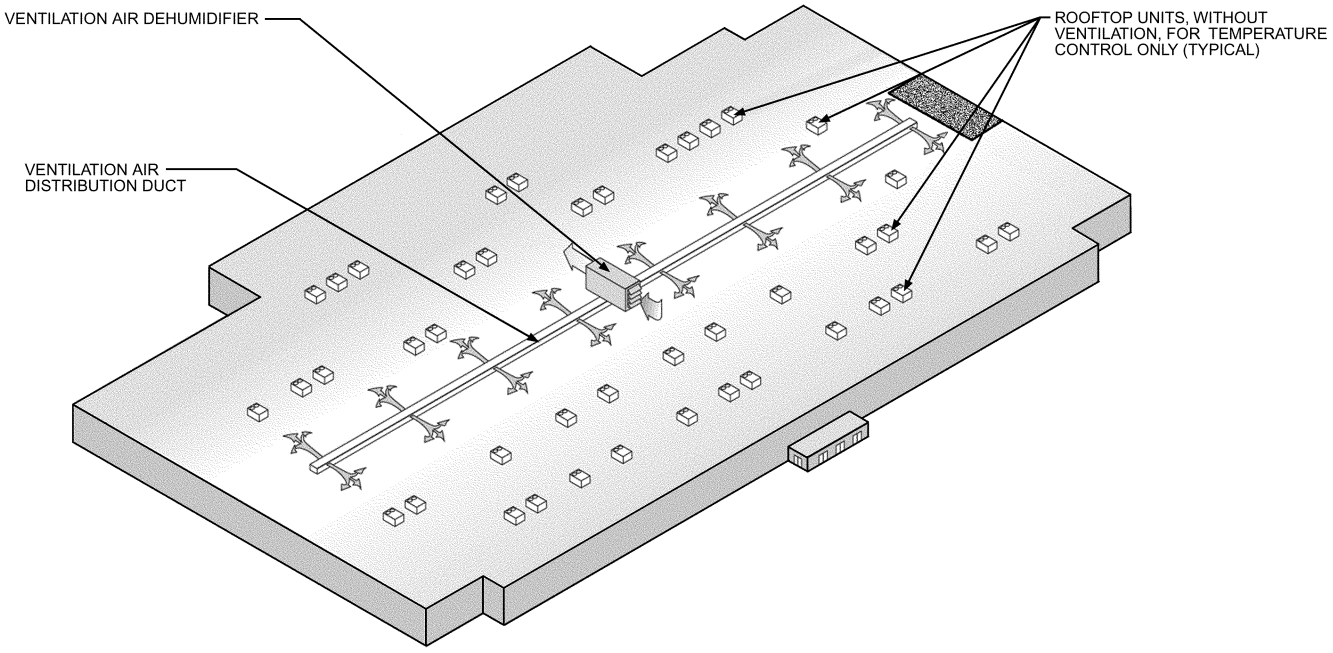

Fig. 1 Example DOAS Configuration for Large Retail Store

(Harriman et al. 2001)

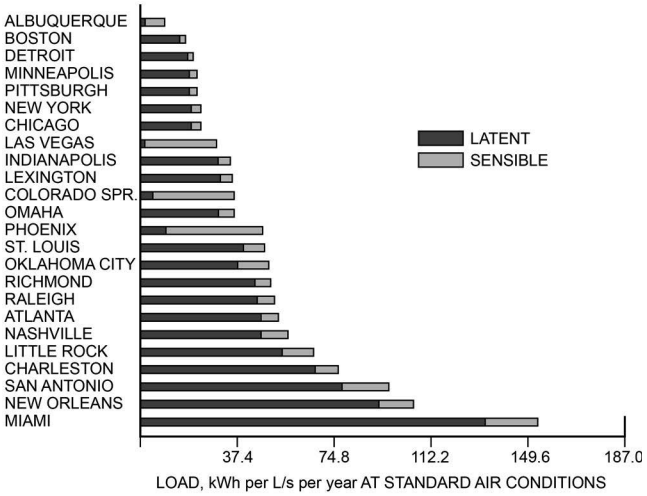

Fig. 2 Annual Cumulative Latent (Dehumidification) and Sensible Cooling Loads from Outdoor Air

(Harriman et al. 2007)

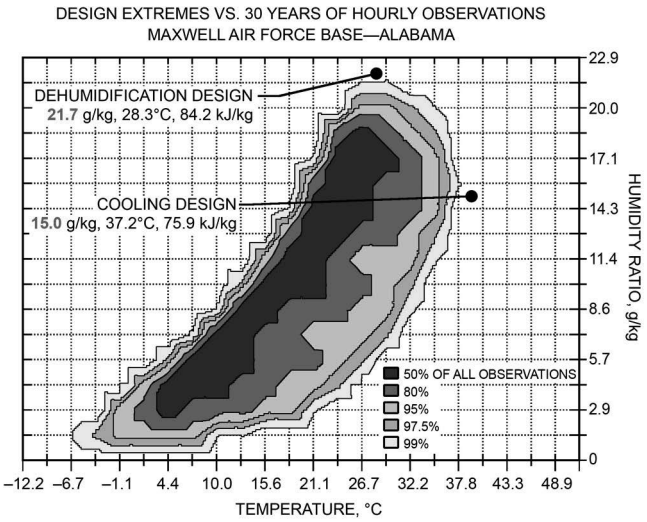

Fig. 3 Design Extreme Weather Conditions

(Harriman et al. 2000)

Annual cumulative latent outdoor air loads typically exceed sensible outdoor air-cooling loads by 3:1 to 5:1 in all but high-altitude and desert climates (Harriman et al. 1997). Figure 2 shows the annual cumulative latent (dehumidification) and sensible cooling loads from outdoor air for several climates. In addition, the outdoor air humidity ratio at cooling design conditions is typically much lower than at the dehumidification design conditions, as is shown for a sample climate in Figure 3. Traditional cooling system designs may be ill equipped to handle such high latent loads (Kosar et al. 1998) over the wide range of ambient conditions. A dedicated dehumidification component in a DOAS can remove the latent outdoor air load and the latent indoor load, when outdoor air is dried deeply, often avoiding the need for the local cooling equipment to cool the air too low for the sensible cooling load and then need to use reheat (Figure 4).

Because of widespread adoption of light-emitting diode (LED) lighting and low-solar-heat-gain coefficient windows, internal sensible cooling loads have been greatly reduced while the outdoor air

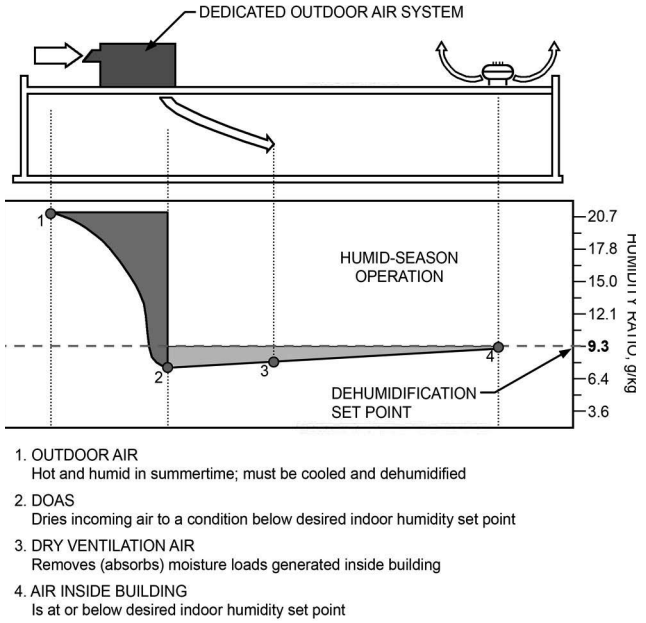

Fig. 4 Typical DOAS Configuration Diagram during Humid-Season Operation

(Harriman et al. 2001)

load has remained high. Consequently, using a DOAS to separate the dehumidification work from the space sensible cooling work may reduce the overall cost of the mechanical system (particularly if energy recovery is included in the DOAS), because the sensible cooling equipment often can be downsized to help offset the cost of the DOAS.

Humidity control also plays a vital role in maintaining healthy buildings and occupant health. Persistent indoor dampness is neither normal nor desirable and can lead to health risks for occupants in the short term and ultimately to structural risks. In addition, during the COVID-19 pandemic, the ASHRAE Epidemic Task Force shared guidance on how indoor humidity plays a role in reducing the spread of airborne infectious aerosols.

1.2 ENERGY IMPACT

Reducing energy consumption in buildings has had a much greater influence on design decisions over recent years. Due in part to this increased awareness of efficiency, DOAS has gained in popularity and emerged as an effective, cost-efficient approach to reducing energy use.

One important way that DOAS contributes to energy savings is by removing humidity from outdoor air, which allows the remaining cooling components to operate solely for sensible cooling. This can avoid the need to overcool and reheat supply air, and allow the local cooling equipment to operate at a warmer temperature, which can reduce compressor lift and improve efficiency.

Another energy benefit is that less outdoor air may need to be introduced to the building, compared to a typical mixed-air system that must meet the multiple-zone recirculating system requirements of ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1. Reducing outdoor air intake saves energy by reducing the outdoor air heating, cooling, and dehumidification loads.

In addition, DOAS can make it easier to implement demand-controlled ventilation (DCV) strategies. Traditional designs often ignore the issue of reducing outdoor air when spaces are partially occupied or unoccupied, which impacts energy consumption

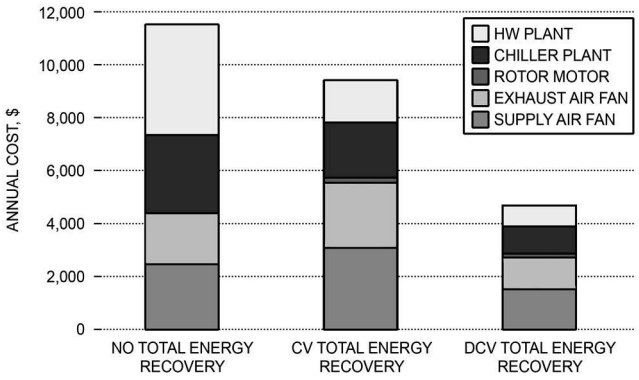

Fig. 5 Demand-Controlled Ventilation Benefits in DOAS

(Crowther and Ma 2016)

(Crowther and Ma 2016; Persily et al. 2005). With the right components installed, a DOAS can allow outdoor air to be reduced in response to changes in space occupancy. Figure 5 shows an example of the potential DOAS energy savings available from implementing DCV. This figure depicts annual costs for an example building in Chicago using either (1) a constant-volume (CV) DOAS unit with no energy recovery providing outdoor air directly to the spaces, (2) a CV DOAS unit with energy recovery, or (3) a variable-volume DOAS unit with energy recovery and DCV. This analysis assumes 50% average occupancy during operating hours and 12.8°C summer supply air temperature from the DOAS, which is then reset to 18.3°C in winter. DCV with energy recovery results in 72% DOAS energy savings and a 59% energy cost savings compared to the CV DOAS unit with no energy recovery (Crowther and Ma 2016). When demand-controlled ventilation is implemented, ensure that building pressure is controlled as intake airflow is reduced. Also, if sensible-only cooling equipment is used, the DOAS is the only source of dehumidification, so DCV must ensure that space humidity control is not lost.

Finally, the centralization of outdoor air conditioning provided by DOAS can make it easier to recover both heating and cooling energy from exhaust air. From an installation and operational point of view, DOAS is often the easiest way to provide air-to-air energy recovery, which may be required by ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1. If exhaust air is not easily routable to the DOAS equipment, other energy recovery methods should be used. These include a precool/postheat heat exchanger to precool the incoming outdoor air and transfer this energy to reheat the dehumidified air before it discharges from the unit, liquid desiccant dehumidification, or hot-gas reheat.

Increasing awareness of the energy associated with dehumidification is reflected in new metrics to measure moisture removal. The **moisture removal efficiency (MRE)** assesses the dehumidification energy efficiency of a direct-expansion (DX) DOAS unit in terms of moisture removed per kilowatt-hour (see ANSI/AHRI *Standard* 920 and ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1).

1.3 SYSTEMS WITHOUT VENTILATION CAPABILITIES

Over the last few decades, improvements in building envelope technology, lighting, and other interior equipment have generally lowered sensible cooling demands per unit area. This has led to development and increased use of nontraditional cooling and heating equipment, which may be able to meet these comparatively lower cooling loads more efficiently than all-air systems. Examples include radiant heating and cooling, chilled beams, water- or ground-source heat pumps, sensible-cooling fan-powered units, and variable-refrigerant-flow (VRF) systems. However, because some of this equipment typically has very limited dehumidification capacity, they rely on a separate DOAS to dehumidify outdoor air being brought into the building for ventilation. In some cases, this equipment cannot provide any dehumidification (i.e., sensible cooling only), so the DOAS must remove the entire latent load of the building (e.g., outdoor air plus internal latent loads from people and infiltration). Even if the local HVAC units have some dehumidification capability, designing the DOAS to allow them to operate dry (providing sensible cooling only) can improve their efficiency and affords the opportunity to eliminate the condensate drainage system.

1.4 FIRST-COST REDUCTION

It may sound contradictory that adding a system could reduce the first cost of a project rather than increase it. By addressing outdoor air loads separately, however, a DOAS may be able to reduce the heating and cooling loads that must be met by other components of the HVAC system. This can allow downsizing of these other components (e.g., terminal units, chillers, boilers, air-handling units, ductwork, piping). For example, using a DOAS that handles the entire (outdoor air and internal) latent load with an energy recovery device and a cooling coil at a school might allow downsizing the classroom units' capacity; reducing the central heating and cooling equipment capacities; and reducing the size of piping, ductwork, and electrical distribution.

2. AIR DISTRIBUTION

DOAS units can be described as independent air handlers that condition outdoor air entering a building. They can be integrated with almost any type of heating and cooling system, and typically duct conditioned outdoor air to each zone throughout a building, but there are several options for how the outdoor air is delivered at the zone level (directly to the zone, to local equipment, etc.). The following is an overview of four common DOAS air distribution configurations.

2.1 DIRECT SUPPLY TO EACH ZONE

In this configuration, the DOAS unit supplies conditioned outdoor air directly to each zone through a dedicated duct system and independent space diffusers, as shown in Figure 6. The DOAS unit may be sized to meet both the outdoor air and internal latent loads for the building, allowing the other equipment (either local or central) to address space sensible loads only. This approach is often used when local units are installed in the occupied space, such as packaged terminal air conditioners (PTACs), fan-coils, water-source heat pumps, VRF terminals, passive chilled beams, or radiant panels. This strategy can also be used if the local units are installed in the ceiling plenum, on the roof, or in a closet near the space.

One major advantage of this approach is that it is easy to ensure that the required outdoor airflow reaches each zone, because it can be measured through dedicated diffusers during start-up and balancing. In addition, if outdoor air is delivered at a cold temperature, rather than reheated to close to space set-point temperatures, this configuration offers the opportunity to downsize the local sensible cooling equipment.

The main drawback of this configuration is that it requires installation of additional ductwork and separate diffusers, increasing first costs. These costs can be largely offset, however, by downsizing sensible cooling equipment and saving energy by cycling local sensible-cooling equipment fans off when space temperature is satisfied.

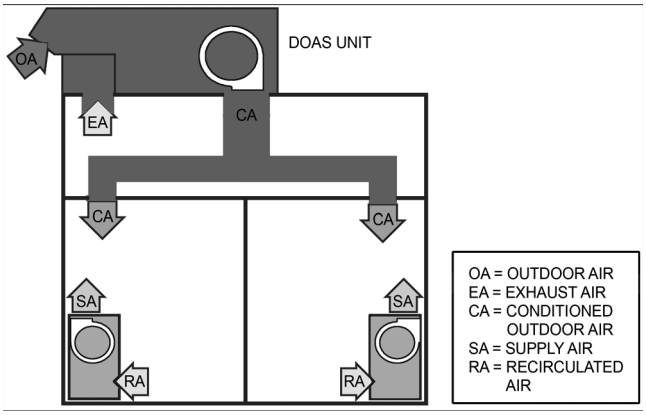

Fig. 6 Schematic of DOAS Supplying Conditioned Outdoor Air Directly to Each Zone

(Mumma et al. 2013)

2.2 SUPPLY TO INTAKE OF LOCAL UNITS

This configuration delivers conditioned outdoor air directly to the intake of each local unit, where it mixes with recirculated air from the zone. The local unit then conditions the mixture and delivers it to the space, thereby ensuring that required outdoor airflows are met. This approach is often used when local units are installed in the ceiling plenum, on the roof, or in a closet. Examples include water-source heat pumps, fan-coils, small rooftop units, or variable-refrigerant-flow (VRF) terminals.

This approach avoids some of the cost and space required to install additional ductwork and separate diffusers. However, because the local fan is used to deliver outdoor air to the zone, it must operate continuously whenever outdoor air is needed during occupancy. If it cycles on and off, or varies its speed, outdoor air delivery is compromised because of the pressure variations. Also, if the local unit ever delivers air at a temperature warmer than the space, outdoor airflow may need to be increased to account for a zone air distribution effectiveness E_z of <1.0 (see ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1). In addition, when the outdoor air is delivered at a cold temperature, it results in cool air entering the coil in the local unit. This must be considered during equipment selection, as it may affect cooling coil capacity and the need for reheat at the local unit.

Measurement/verification of outdoor airflow and balancing are typically more complicated in this scenario than if the outdoor air was delivered directly to the space.

2.3 DELIVERY TO SUPPLY SIDE OF LOCAL UNITS

In this configuration, conditioned outdoor air is ducted directly to the supply-side of each local unit, where it mixes with supply air before being delivered to the zone through a common set of diffusers. This approach also ensures that required outdoor airflows are met, but in this case the local unit conditions only recirculated air.

This strategy is typically used when local units are installed in the ceiling plenum, on the roof, or in a closet. Examples include water-source heat pumps, fan-coils, small rooftop units, active chilled beams, or VRF terminals. If the outdoor air is delivered at a cold temperature, rather than reheated to near space temperature, this configuration offers the opportunity to downsize the local units.

Measurement and balancing, however, are more difficult than for direct delivery of outdoor air to the space. Additionally, the local fans typically need to operate continuously during occupancy to ensure sufficient outdoor air delivery. If the local fan cycles off or varies its speed, pressure in the supply duct decreases; this can interfere with air balancing of the DOAS and may result in backflow through the local units.

One solution is to install a pressure-independent damper or variable-air-volume (VAV) terminal in the DOAS ductwork to each zone to respond to changes in pressure, ensuring that the required outdoor airflow is delivered to the zone regardless of whether the local fan is operating. Including this VAV terminal has the added benefit of providing a means of incorporating demand-controlled ventilation.

If the local unit ever delivers air at a temperature warmer than the space, ventilation may need to be increased to account for $E_z < 1.0$ (ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1).

2.4 SUPPLY TO PLENUM NEAR LOCAL UNITS

In this approach, conditioned outdoor air is delivered to the open ceiling plenum (or closet), near the intake of each local unit. The outdoor air mixes with recirculated air in the plenum or closet before being drawn in through the intake of the local unit.

This strategy is sometimes used when local units are installed in the ceiling plenum or closet, such as water-source heat pumps, fan-coils, or VRF terminals. The primary advantage of this configuration is that it avoids much of the cost and space needed to install additional ductwork, separate diffusers, or mixing plenums on the local units.

However, it is difficult to ensure that the required amount of outdoor air reaches each zone, because it is not ducted directly. For this reason, ASHRAE *Standard* 62.1 contains some words of caution about this approach, and the corresponding *Standard 62.1's User's Manual* provides guidance on how (and how not) to design this type of system to minimize this drawback. For example, the DOAS ductwork should deliver conditioned outdoor air close to the intake of each local unit, and include some means of balancing to ensure that the correct amount of air is supplied to each unit. Additionally, the conditioned outdoor air typically cannot be delivered at a cold temperature in this configuration; in most cases, it must be reheated to avoid condensation on surfaces within the plenum or closet.

Because of these drawbacks, it is wise to consult both local codes and ASHRAE standards before designing a system that uses this configuration.

3. EQUIPMENT CONFIGURATIONS

DOAS units can incorporate a wide range of components, depending on the specific needs of the project. Common equipment components include

- Supply and/or exhaust fans
- Variable-speed drives
- Air-to-air energy recovery devices (coil loops, heat pipes, plate or membrane heat exchangers, wheels)
- Cooling coils (DX, chilled water)
- Desiccant dehumidification wheels or liquid desiccant systems
- Heating coils (hot water, indirect gas-fired, or electric)
- Humidifiers
- Condenser heat recovery coils (hot-gas reheat)
- Motorized dampers
- Filters and other air cleaning devices
- Ultraviolet lights

The chosen combination of these components varies, depending on the application and climate. One typical configuration, shown in Figure 7, includes a total energy recovery wheel, a cooling coil, and a heating coil. The process is shown in the psychrometric chart for a winter and a summer condition. The outdoor air is preconditioned by the total energy wheel, reducing the amount of cooling and

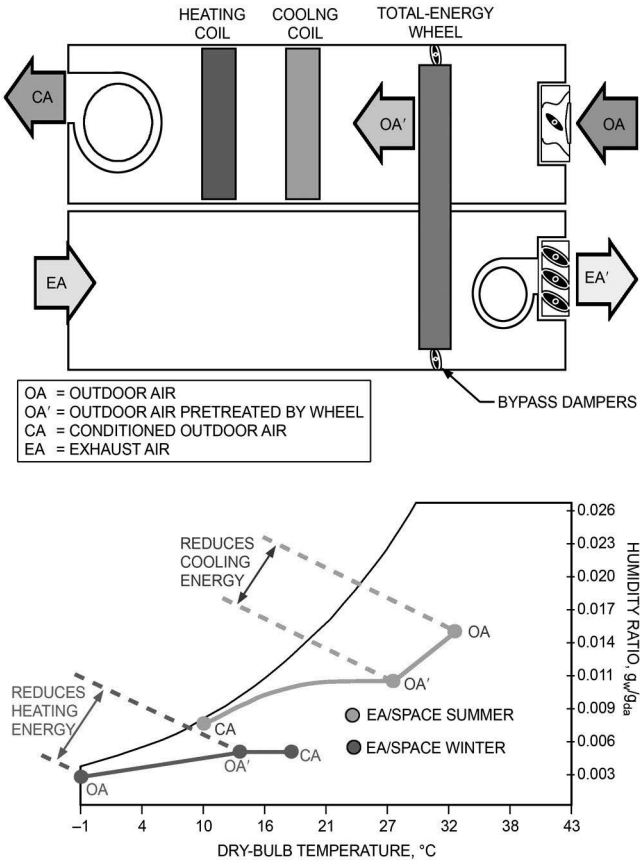

Fig. 7 Common DOAS Equipment Configuration with Total-Energy Wheel

(Mumma et al. 2013)

dehumidification required in the summer and reducing the amount of heating required in the winter. The heating coil preheats the outdoor air before the air leaves the DOAS when it is cold outdoors, while the cooling coil dehumidifies and cools the outdoor air when it is hot and/or humid.

Another configuration, shown in Figure 8, includes a sensible energy recovery device (e.g., heat pipe [shown in Figure 8], coil loop, plate heat exchanger, wheel) in series with a cooling coil. The process is shown in the psychrometric chart for a summer condition. Outdoor air is precooled by the heat pipe, reducing the amount of cooling (and sometimes dehumidification) required. This heat is then transferred to reheat the dehumidified air leaving the cooling coil.

When selecting DOAS system configuration, the designer should be aware that

- Energy consumption of the DOAS fan(s) should be designed to be as small as possible.
- The typical function of DOAS units is to dry incoming outdoor air to a low dew point. If using DX cooling coils, determine what the lowest temperature leaving the DOAS will be, given the deepest cooling required of the compressors, and make sure this will not overcool occupied spaces or increase condensation in ducts. ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 cautions that, when reheat is needed to avoid overcooling, it is best to use recovered heat (e.g., condenser or compressor heat, waste heat) rather than new energy.
- Demand-controlled ventilation (DCV) with variable-speed fan drives or multispeed fans should be an option if the required rate of outdoor airflow will vary, as with minimum nighttime or weekend ventilation versus maximum ventilation during fully occupied hours.

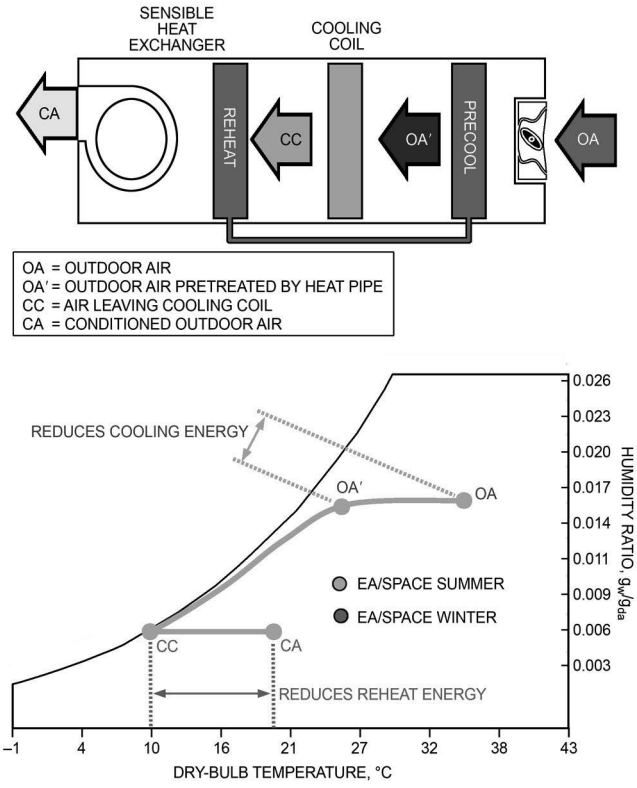

Fig. 8 Common DOAS Equipment Configuration with Wraparound Heat Pipe

- Incoming outdoor air must be filtered to protect the DOAS components. Beyond the minimum needed for equipment protection, be aware that removing particulate matter is a concern, and that filtration of the relatively small outdoor airstream is typically less costly than filtration after the outdoor air is mixed with recirculated return air to form a much larger air volume (Stephens et al. 2016).
- Avoid overheating incoming outdoor air during swing seasons. The DOAS unit should preferably not use heat or heat recovery to warm the supply air when the building is predominantly in cooling mode; if heating is necessary, it should not be to above 15.6°C. This may require a controllable heat/energy recovery device. When it is cold outdoors, however, the DOAS unit may be used to heat the incoming air. How much heating capacity is required depends on whether exhaust-air energy recovery is used, if the unit will be used for heating during unoccupied periods or morning warmup, and whether the terminal equipment is capable of heating.

3.1 CLIMATE IMPLICATIONS

When choosing a DOAS equipment configuration, climate is one of the primary drivers.

In hot, humid climates (e.g., Miami, Singapore), active humidity control is a primary focus, and energy recovery devices combined with deep cooling coils and/or desiccant dehumidification devices are typically used to remove the constantly high latent loads.

For exceptionally hot and dry (e.g., Las Vegas) or dry, high-altitude climates (e.g., Bogotá, Mexico City), dehumidification may be less of a concern, and sensible heat recovery and cooling are a more constant need.

Table 1 Example of Dedicated Outdoor Air Unit Control Modes

Control Mode	Outdoor Air Conditions
Dehumidification and cooling	Outdoor air dew point > Dehumidification enable set point
Sensible cooling	Outdoor air dew point ≤ Dehumidification enable set point Outdoor air dry bulb > Cooling enable set point
Ventilation only	Outdoor air dew point ≤ Dehumidification enable set point Heating enable set point ≤ Outdoor air dry-bulb temperature ≤ Cooling enable set point
Heating	Outdoor air dew point ≤ Dehumidification enable set point Outdoor air dry bulb < Heating enable set point

In cold climates (e.g., Minneapolis, Moscow), recovering exhaust heat and/or providing heating in the DOAS is the primary consideration.

In mild climates (e.g., Seattle, Copenhagen), except for filtration, outdoor air is within an acceptable range of conditions for a considerable amount of time, so a DOAS might have less energy savings benefit and a controllable energy recovery device is warranted.

3.2 ELECTRIFICATION

With sustainability a key focus of policy makers, businesses, and consumers, there has been increased interest in reducing the carbon dioxide equivalent footprint of buildings (often referred to as **decarbonization**). In the context of the HVAC system, this involves improving the energy efficiency of the system, using low-global-warming-potential (GWP) refrigerants and reducing leaks of those refrigerants, and reducing the use of fossil fuels by installing electrified HVAC equipment that is served by electrical grids that rely more heavily on carbon-free energy sources such as solar, wind, and other renewables.

With respect to DOAS, electrification typically focuses on the technology used to heat the incoming outdoor air. Some strategies that can help in electrification include the following:

- Incorporating exhaust-air energy recovery and/or demand-controlled ventilation to reduce wintertime heating loads due to the introduction of outdoor air.
- Using heat pump technology for heating, rather than burners or boilers that use fossil fuels. For projects with sufficient land available, geothermal can be an option. Otherwise, air-source heat pump technology is available in many product platforms.
- If using an air-source heat pump, include a backup heat source in colder climates to avoid delivery of subfreezing air in the event that the heat pump has insufficient capacity or has to switch temporarily to operate in defrost mode.

4. CONTROL

Basic DOAS modes of operation for various outdoor conditions are shown in Figure 9 and Table 1. When it is hot and humid outdoors, the DOAS should dehumidify and cool the incoming outdoor air (dehumidification and cooling mode), but if it is hot and dry outdoors, the DOAS may only need to provide sensible cooling without dehumidification (sensible cooling mode). When it is cold outdoors, the DOAS may need to heat the incoming outdoor air (heating mode).

DOAS does not typically have a traditional economizer mode, since the system is most commonly designed for minimum required ventilation and thus is not able to deliver 100% of supply airflow for cooling when outdoor conditions allow free cooling. However, there is a ventilation-only (or fan-only) mode, for use when the current outdoor conditions are such that the dehumidification, cooling, and heating components can be shut off.

In addition to humidity control during occupied periods when ventilation is required, the DOAS can be used to control humidity during the unoccupied period (especially if equipped with a recirculating air damper). In this mode, the DOAS closes the outdoor air damper and opens the recirculating air damper, allowing recirculated return air to pass through the DOAS and be dehumidified. This ensures that the building stays dry when unoccupied. This can be particularly useful in climates where the outdoor dew point is higher than the occupied indoor temperature, because walls and other indoor surfaces stay cold for a while after a setback is enabled, and infiltration of humid outdoor air may cause the indoor dew point to rise above indoor surface temperatures, causing condensation.

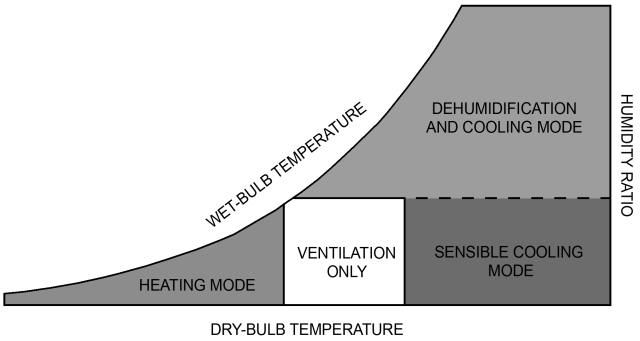

Fig. 9 Example of Dedicated Outdoor Air Unit Control Modes

(Murphy and Bradley 2012)

4.1 METHODS TO AVOID OVERCOOLING CONDITIONED SPACES

The dry-bulb temperature at which air leaves the DOAS unit is typically a result of the dehumidification process. Generally, it is most energy efficient and cost effective to deliver the conditioned outdoor air as close as possible to the temperature that results from conditioning (dehumidifying in most cases), as long as it is acceptable for comfort in the space and consistent with the capabilities of the local equipment. Recognizing the inefficiency of reheat in a DOAS, ASHRAE *Standard* 90.1 now prohibits heating or reheating the outdoor air to any warmer than 16°C whenever the majority of zones require cooling.

Although controlling the leaving-air temperature of a DOAS is not significantly different from a traditional system, determining whether to reheat may be somewhat different for a DOAS. Although the primary functions of a DOAS unit are outdoor air delivery and dehumidification, it should also assist in addressing space cooling loads if possible.

The amount of air delivered to the spaces from the DOAS is typically less than the minimum setting of a VAV terminal in a mixed-air system, because the DOAS provides only outdoor air. In a few cases, even this relatively small amount of cool air can be too much for the zone. If this happens, there are a few options to avoid overcooling:

- **Implement demand-controlled ventilation**: DCV reduces the flow rate of cool, dehumidified outdoor air delivered to the space during periods of reduced occupancy, reducing the chance that the

space temperature will get too low. This is the most energy-efficient method (because it also reduces DOAS fan, cooling, and heating energy use), but has higher first cost.

- **Activate heat in local HVAC unit**: If the space temperature drops too low, local space heating devices (e.g., fan-coils, radiators, heat pumps, VRF terminals) can be activated. When only a few zones require heat, this is more energy efficient than reheating in the DOAS, because the other spaces still benefit from the cooling provided by the DOAS and do not need as much additional local cooling.
- **Reheat dehumidified air at the DOAS unit**: When several zones require heating, it might be more efficient to reheat the dehumidified outdoor air centrally in the DOAS unit, especially if recovered heat is available (e.g., waste heat, heat from DX condensers inside the unit itself).

To minimize the amount of reheat required, the DOAS supply-air temperature might be reset up from the required leaving-air dew-point temperature whenever the outdoor dew-point temperature is lower than the required leaving-air dew-point temperature.

Similar strategies can also be used during cold weather to determine how much to heat the incoming outdoor air.

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CHAPTER 52

CODES AND STANDARDS

THE codes and standards and other publications listed here represent practices, methods, or standard published by the organizations indicated. They are useful guides for the practicing engineer in determining test methods, ratings, performance requirements, and limits of HVAC&R equipment. Copies of these publications can be obtained from most of the organizations listed in the Publisher column, from Global Engineering Documents at **global.ihs.com**, or from Techstreet at **techstreet.com**. Addresses of the organizations are given at the end of the chapter.

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
Air Conditioners	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Residential Equipment Selection, 2nd ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S®-2014
	HVAC Quality Installation Specification	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Quality Installations	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Laboratory Methods of Testing Air Terminal Units	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 130-2016
	Non-Ducted Air Conditioners and Heat Pumps—Testing and Rating for Performance	ISO	ISO 5151:2010
	Ducted Air-Conditioners and Air-to-Air Heat Pumps—Testing and Rating for Performance	ISO	ISO 13253:2011
	Guidelines for Roof Mounted Outdoor Air-Conditioner Installations	SMACNA	SMACNA 1997
	Heating and Cooling Equipment	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 1995-2011/C22.2 No. 236-11
	Performance Standard for Split-System and Single-Package Central Air Conditioners and Heat Pumps	CSA	CAN/CSA-C656-14
	Performance Standard for Rating Large and Single Packaged Air Conditioners and Heat Pumps	CSA	CAN/CSA-C746-06 (R2012)
Gas-Fired	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Residential Equipment Selection, 2nd ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 12 QH-2014
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ACCA 2014
	Gas-Fired, Heat Activated Air Conditioning and Heat Pump Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.40.1-1996/CGA 2.91-M96 (R2012)
	Gas-Fired Work Activated Air Conditioning and Heat Pump Appliances (Internal Combustion)	CSA	ANSI Z21.40.2-1996/CGA 2.92-M96 (R2002)
	Performance Testing and Rating of Gas-Fired Air Conditioning and Heat Pump Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.40.4-1996/CGA 2.94-M96 (R2002)
Packaged Terminal	Packaged Terminal Air-Conditioners and Heat Pumps	AHRI/CSA	AHRI 310/380-2014/CSA C744-14
Room	Room Air Conditioners	AHAM	ANSI/AHAM RAC-1-2014
	Method of Testing for Rating Room Air Conditioners and Packaged Terminal Air Conditioners	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 16-2016
	Method of Testing for Rating Room Air Conditioner and Packaged Terminal Air Conditioner Heating Capacity	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 58-1986 (RA14)
	Method of Testing for Rating Fan-Coil Conditioners	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 79-2015
	Energy Performance of Room Air Conditioners	CSA	CAN/CSA-C368.1-14
	Room Air Conditioners	CSA	C22.2 No. 117-1970 (R2012)
	Room Air Conditioners, Ed. 7	UL	ANSI/UL 484-2014
Unitary	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Residential Equipment Selection, 2nd ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	Unitary Air-Conditioning and Air-Source Heat Pump Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 210/240-2008
	Sound Rating of Outdoor Unitary Equipment	AHRI	AHRI 270-2008
	Application of Sound Rating Levels of Outdoor Unitary Equipment	AHRI	AHRI 275-2010
	Commercial and Industrial Unitary Air-Conditioning and Heat Pump Equipment	AHRI	AHRI 340/360-2007
	Methods of Testing for Rating Electrically Driven Unitary Air-Conditioning and Heat Pump Equipment	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 37-2009
	Methods of Testing for Rating Heat Operated Unitary Air-Conditioning and Heat-Pump Equipment	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 40-2014
	Methods of Testing for Rating Seasonal Efficiency of Unitary Air Conditioners and Heat Pumps	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 116-2010
	Method of Testing for Rating Computer and Data Processing Room Unitary Air Conditioners	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 127-2020
	Method of Rating Unitary Spot Air Conditioners	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 128-2011

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
Ships	Specification for Mechanically Refrigerated Shipboard Air Conditioner	ASTM	ASTM F1433-97 (2010)
Accessories	Flashing and Stand Combination for Air Conditioning Units (Unit Curb)	IAPMO	IAPMO PS 120-2004
Air Conditioning	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Heat Pump Systems	ACCA	ACCA Manual H-1984
	Residential Load Calculation, 8th ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 2 Manual J-2016
	Commercial Load Calculation, 5th ed.	ACCA	ACCA Manual N-2012
	Comfort, Air Quality, and Efficiency by Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual RS-1997
	HVAC Quality Installation Specification	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Quality Installations	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Peak Cooling and Heating Load Calculations in Buildings Except Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE/ ACCA	ANSI/ASHRAE/ACCA 183-2024
	Environmental Systems Technology, 2nd ed. (1999)	NEBB	NEBB
	Installation of Air-Conditioning and Ventilating Systems	NFPA	NFPA 90A-2015
	Standard of Purity for Use in Mobile Air-Conditioning Systems	SAE	SAE J1991-2011
	HVAC Systems Applications, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2010
	HVAC Systems—Duct Design, 4th ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2006
	Heating and Cooling Equipment	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 1995-2011/C22.2 No. 236-11
Aircraft	Air Conditioning of Aircraft Cargo	SAE	SAE AIR806B-1997 (R2011)
	Aircraft Fuel Weight Penalty Due to Air Conditioning	SAE	SAE AIR1168/8-2011
	Air Conditioning Systems for Subsonic Airplanes	SAE	SAE ARP85F-2012
	Environmental Control Systems Terminology	SAE	SAE ARP147E-2001 (R2012)
	Testing of Airplane Installed Environmental Control Systems (ECS)	SAE	SAE ARP217D-1999 (R2011)
	Guide for Qualification Testing of Aircraft Air Valves	SAE	SAE ARP986D-2008
	Control of Excess Humidity in Avionics Cooling	SAE	SAE ARP987B-2010
	Engine Bleed Air Systems for Aircraft	SAE	SAE ARP1796B-2012
	Aircraft Ground Air Conditioning Service Connection	SAE	SAE AS4262B-2012
	Air Cycle Air Conditioning Systems for Military Air Vehicles	SAE	SAE AS4073A-2013
Automotive	Refrigerant 12 Automotive Air-Conditioning Hose	SAE	SAE J51-2004
	Design Guidelines for Air Conditioning Systems for Off-Road Operator Enclosures	SAE	SAE J169-2013
	Test Method for Measuring Power Consumption of Air Conditioning and Brake Compressors for Trucks and Buses	SAE	SAE J1340-2011
	Information Relating to Duty Cycles and Average Power Requirements of Truck and Bus Engine Accessories	SAE	SAE J1343-2000
	Rating Air-Conditioner Evaporator Air Delivery and Cooling Capacities	SAE	SAE J1487-2013
	Recovery and Recycle Equipment for Mobile Automotive Air-Conditioning Systems	SAE	SAE J1990-2011
	R134a Refrigerant Automotive Air-Conditioning Hose	SAE	SAE J2064-2011
	Service Hose for Automotive Air Conditioning	SAE	SAE J2196-2011
Ships	Mechanical Refrigeration and Air-Conditioning Installations Aboard Ship	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 26-2010 (RA20)
	Practice for Mechanical Symbols, Shipboard Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning (HVAC)	ASTM	ASTM F856-97 (2014)
Air Curtains	Laboratory Methods of Testing Air Curtains for Aerodynamic Performance	AMCA	AMCA 220-05 (R2012)
	Air Terminals	AHRI	AHRI 881-2011
	Standard Methods for Laboratory Airflow Measurement	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 41.2-2022
	Method of Testing the Performance of Air Outlets and Inlets	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 70-2023
	Residential Mechanical Ventilating Systems	CSA	CAN/CSA-F326-M91 (R2010)
	Air Curtains for Entranceways in Food and Food Service Establishments	NSF	ANSI/NSF 37-2012
Air Diffusion	Air Distribution Basics for Residential and Small Commercial Buildings	ACCA	ACCA Manual T-2001
	Balancing and Testing Air and Hydronic Systems	ACCA	ACCA Manual B-2009
	Method of Testing the Performance of Air Outlets and Inlets	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 70-2023
	Method of Testing for Room Air Diffusion	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 113-2022
Air Filters	Comfort, Air Quality, and Efficiency by Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual RS-1997
	Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 12 QH-2014
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Balancing and Testing Air and Hydronic Systems	ACCA	ACCA Manual B-2009
	Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice, 29th ed. (2016)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Air Cleaners—Portable	AHAM	ANSI/AHAM AC-1-2013
	Residential Air Filter Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 681-2009
	Commercial and Industrial Air Filter Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 850-2013
	Method of Testing General Ventilation Air-Cleaning Devices for Removal Efficiency by Particle Size	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 52.2-2012

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Laboratory Test Method for Assessing the Performance of Gas-Phase Air Cleaning Systems: Loose Granular Media	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 145.1-2015
	Laboratory Test Method for Assessing the Performance of Gas-Phase Air Cleaning Systems: Air Cleaning Devices	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 145.2-2016
	Code on Nuclear Air and Gas Treatment	ASME	ASME AG-1-2012
	Nuclear Power Plant Air-Cleaning Units and Components	ASME	ASME N509-2002
	Testing of Nuclear Air-Treatment Systems	ASME	ASME N510-2007
	Test Method for Air Cleaning Performance of a High-Efficiency Particulate Air Filter System	ASTM	ASTM F1471-09
	Specification for Filters Used in Air or Nitrogen Systems	ASTM	ASTM F1791-00 (2013)
	Method for Sodium Flame Test for Air Filters	BSI	BS 3928:1969
	Particulate Air Filters for General Ventilation: Determination of Filtration Performance	BSI	BS EN 779:2002
	Electrostatic Air Cleaners	UL	ANSI/UL 867-2011
	High-Efficiency, Particulate, Air Filter Units	UL	ANSI/UL 586-2009
	Air Filter Units	UL	ANSI/UL 900-2004
	Exhaust Hoods for Commercial Cooking Equipment	UL	UL 710-2012
	Grease Filters for Exhaust Ducts	UL	UL 1046-2010
Air-Handling Units	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Residential Equipment Selection	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	Central Station Air-Handling Units	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 430-2014
	Non-Recirculating Direct Gas-Fired Industrial Air Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z83.4-2013/CSA 3.7-2013
Air Leakage	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Duct Diagnostics and Repair	ACCA	ACCA 2016
	HVAC Quality Installation Specification	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Quality Installations	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Ventilation and Acceptable Indoor Air Quality in Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 62.2-2022
	Method of Test for Determining the Airtightness of HVAC Equipment	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 193-2010 (RA24)
	Test Method for Determining Air Change in a Single Zone by Means of a Tracer Gas Dilution	ASTM	ASTM E741-11
	Test Method for Determining Air Leakage Rate by Fan Pressurization	ASTM	ASTM E779-10
	Test Method for Field Measurement of Air Leakage Through Installed Exterior Window and Doors	ASTM	ASTM E783-02 (2010)
	Practices for Air Leakage Site Detection in Building Envelopes and Air Barrier Systems	ASTM	ASTM E1186-03 (2009)
	Test Method for Determining the Rate of Air Leakage Through Exterior Windows, Curtain Walls, and Doors Under Specified Pressure and Temperature Differences Across the Specimen	ASTM	ASTM E1424-91 (2008)
	Test Methods for Determining Airtightness of Buildings Using an Orifice Blower Door	ASTM	ASTM E1827-11
	Practice for Determining the Effects of Temperature Cycling on Fenestration Products	ASTM	ASTM E2264-05 (2013)
	Test Method for Determining Air Flow Through the Face and Sides of Exterior Windows, Curtain Walls, and Doors Under Specified Pressure Differences Across the Specimen	ASTM	ASTM E2319-04 (2011)
	Test Method for Determining Air Leakage of Air Barrier Assemblies	ASTM	ASTM E2357-11
	HVAC Air Duct Leakage Test Manual, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2012
Boilers	Packaged Boiler Engineering Manual (1998)	ABMA	ABMA 100
	Selected Codes and Standards of the Boiler Industry (2001)	ABMA	ABMA 103
	Operation and Maintenance Safety Manual (1995)	ABMA	ABMA 106
	Fluidized Bed Combustion Guidelines (1995)	ABMA	ABMA 200
	Guide to Clean and Efficient Operation of Coal Stoker-Fired Boilers (2002)	ABMA	ABMA 203
	Guideline for Performance Evaluation of Heat Recovery Steam Generating Equipment (1995)	ABMA	ABMA 300
	Guidelines for Industrial Boiler Performance Improvement (1999)	ABMA	ABMA 302
	Measurement of Sound from Steam Generators (1995)	ABMA	ABMA 304
	Guideline for Gas and Oil Emission Factors for Industrial, Commercial, and Institutional Boilers (1997)	ABMA	ABMA 305
	Combustion Control Guidelines for Single Burner Firetube and Watertube Industrial/Commercial/Institutional Boilers (1999)	ABMA	ABMA 307
	Combustion Control Guidelines for Multiple-Burner Boilers (2001)	ABMA	ABMA 308
	Boiler Water Quality Requirements and Associated Steam Quality for Industrial/Commercial and Institutional Boilers (2005)	ABMA	ABMA 402
	HVAC Quality Installation Specification	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Quality Installations	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Residential Equipment Selection	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S 2014
	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Method of Testing for Annual Fuel Utilization Efficiency of Residential Central Furnaces and Boilers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 103-2022
	Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code—Section I: Power Boilers; Section IV: Heating Boilers	ASME	BPVC-2015
	Fired Steam Generators	ASME	ASME PTC 4-2013
	Boiler, Pressure Vessel, and Pressure Piping Code	CSA	CSA B51-14
	Testing Standard, Method to Determine Efficiency of Commercial Heating Boilers, 2nd ed. (2007)	HYDI	HYDI BTS-2000
	Rating Procedure for Heating Boilers, 6th ed. (2005)	HYDI	IBR
	Single Burner Boiler Operations	NFPA	ANSI/NFPA 8501-97
	Prevention of Furnace Explosions/Implosions in Multiple Burner Boilers	NFPA	ANSI /NFPA 8502-99
	Heating, Water Supply, and Power Boilers—Electric	UL	ANSI/UL 834-2004
	Boiler and Combustion Systems Hazards Code	NFPA	NFPA 85-11
Gas or Oil	Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 12QH-2014
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Controls and Safety Devices for Automatically Fired Boilers	ASME	ASME CSD-1-2012
	Gas-Fired Low-Pressure Steam and Hot Water Boilers	CSA	ANSI Z21.13-2014/CSA 4.9-2014
	Industrial and Commercial Gas-Fired Package Boilers	CSA	CAN 1-3.1-77 (R2011)
	Oil-Burning Equipment: Steam and Hot-Water Boilers	CSA	B140.7-05 (R2010)
	Oil-Fired Boiler Assemblies	UL	UL 726-1995
	Commercial-Industrial Gas Heating Equipment	UL	UL 795-2011
	Standards and Typical Specifications for Tray Type Deaerators, 9th ed. (2011)	HEI	HEI 2954
Terminology	Ultimate Boiler Industry Lexicon: Handbook of Power Utility and Boiler Terms and Phrases, 6th ed. (2001)	ABMA	ABMA 101
Building Codes	ASTM Standards Used in Building Codes	ASTM	ASTM
	Practice for Conducting Visual Assessments for Lead Hazards in Buildings	ASTM	ASTM E2255M-13
	Standard Practice for Periodic Inspection of Building Facades for Unsafe Conditions	ASTM	ASTM E2270-14
	Standard Practice for Building Enclosure Commissioning	ASTM	ASTM E2813-12
	Structural Welding Code—Steel	AWS	AWS D1.1M/D1.1:2010
	BOCA National Building Code, 14th ed. (1999)	BOCA	BNBC
	Uniform Building Code, vol. 1, 2, and 3 (1997)	ICBO	UBC V1, V2, V3
	International Building Code® (2015)	ICC	IBC
	International Code Council Performance Code® (2015)	ICC	ICC PC
	International Existing Building Code® (2015)	ICC	IEBC
	International Energy Conservation Code® (2015)	ICC	IECC
	International Property Maintenance Code® (2015)	ICC	IPMC
	International Residential Code® (2015)	ICC	IRC
	Building Construction and Safety Code®	NFPA	ANSI/NFPA 5000-2015
	National Building Code of Canada (2010)	NRCC	NRCC
	Standard Building Code (1999)	SBCCI	SBC
Mechanical	Safety Code for Elevators and Escalators	ASME	ASME A17.1-2013
	Natural Gas and Propane Installation Code	CSA	CAN/CSA-B149.1-10
	Propane Storage and Handling Code	CSA	CAN/CSA-B149.2-10
	Uniform Mechanical Code (2012)	IAPMO	IAPMO
	International Mechanical Code® (2015)	ICC	IMC
	International Fuel Gas Code® (2015)	ICC	IFGC
	Standard Gas Code (1999)	SBCCI	SBC
Burners	Domestic Gas Conversion Burners	CSA	ANSI Z21.17-1998/CSA 2.7-M98 (R2014)
	Installation of Domestic Gas Conversion Burners	CSA	ANSI Z21.8-1994 (R2012)
	Installation Code for Oil Burning Equipment	CSA	CAN/CSA-B139-09 (R2014)
	Oil-Burning Equipment: General Requirements	CSA	CAN/CSA-B140.0-03 (R2013)
	Vapourizing-Type Oil Burners	CSA	B140.1-1966 (R2011)
	Atomizing-Type Oil Burners	CSA	CAN/CSA-B140.2.1-10
	Pressure Atomizing Oil Burner Nozzles	CSA	B140.2.2-1971 (R2011)
	Oil Burners	UL	ANSI/UL 296-2003
	Waste Oil-Burning Air-Heating Appliances	UL	ANSI/UL 296A-1995
	Commercial-Industrial Gas Heating Equipment	UL	UL 795-2011
	Commercial/Industrial Gas and/or Oil-Burning Assemblies with Emission Reduction Equipment	UL	UL 2096-2006
Chillers	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Absorption Water Chilling and Water Heating Packages	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 560-2000
	Water Chilling Packages Using the Vapor Compression Cycle	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 551/591-2011

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Method of Testing Liquid-Chilling Packages	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 30-1995
	Method of Testing Absorption Water-Chilling and Water-Heating Packages	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 182-2020
	Performance Standard for Rating Packaged Water Chillers	CSA	CAN/CSA C743-09
Chimneys	Specification for Clay Flue Liners	ASTM	ASTM C315-07 (2011)
	Specification for Industrial Chimney Lining Brick	ASTM	ASTM C980-13a
	Practice for Installing Clay Flue Lining	ASTM	ASTM C1283-11
	Guide for Design and Construction of Brick Liners for Industrial Chimneys	ASTM	ASTM C1298-95 (2013)
	Guide for Design, Fabrication, and Erection of Fiberglass Reinforced Plastic (FRP) Chimney Liners with Coal-Fired Units	ASTM	ASTM D5364-14
	Chimneys, Fireplaces, Vents, and Solid Fuel-Burning Appliances	NFPA	ANSI/NFPA 211-2013
	Medium Heat Appliance Factory-Built Chimneys	UL	ANSI/UL 959-2010
	Factory-Built Chimneys for Residential Type and Building Heating Appliance	UL	ANSI/UL 103-2010
Cleanrooms	Practice for Cleaning and Maintaining Controlled Areas and Clean Rooms	ASTM	ASTM E2042/E2042M-09
	Practice for Design and Construction of Aerospace Cleanrooms and Contamination Controlled Areas	ASTM	ASTM E2217-12
	Practice for Tests of Cleanroom Materials	ASTM	ASTM E2312-11
	Practice for Aerospace Cleanrooms and Associated Controlled Environments—Cleanroom Operations	ASTM	ASTM E2352-04 (2010)
	Test Method for Sizing and Counting Airborne Particulate Contamination in Clean Rooms and Other Dust-Controlled Areas Designed for Electronic and Similar Applications	ASTM	ASTM F25/F25M-09
	Practice for Continuous Sizing and Counting of Airborne Particles in Dust-Controlled Areas and Clean Rooms Using Instruments Capable of Detecting Single Sub-Micrometre and Larger Particles	ASTM	ASTM F50-12
	Procedural Standards for Certified Testing of Cleanrooms, 3rd ed. (2009)	NEBB	NEBB
Climate Data	Residential Load Calculations	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 2 Manual J-2016
	Commercial Load Calculations	ACCA	ACCA Manual N-2012
	Climatic Data for Building Design Standards	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 169-2021
Coils	Forced-Circulation Air-Cooling and Air-Heating Coils	AHRI	AHRI 410-2001
	Methods of Testing Forced Circulation Air Cooling and Air Heating Coils	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 33-2016
Comfort Conditions	Threshold Limit Values for Physical Agents (updated annually)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Comfort, Air Quality, and Efficiency by Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual RS-1997
	Thermal Environmental Conditions for Human Occupancy	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 55-2023
	Classification for Serviceability of an Office Facility for Thermal Environment and Indoor Air Conditions	ASTM	ASTM E2320-04 (2012)
	Hot Environments—Estimation of the Heat Stress on Working Man, Based on the WBGT Index (Wet Bulb Globe Temperature)	ISO	ISO 7243:1989
	Ergonomics of the Thermal Environment—Analytical Determination and Interpretation of Thermal Comfort Using Calculation of the PMV and PPD Indices and Local Thermal Comfort Criteria	ISO	ISO 7730:2005
	Ergonomics of the Thermal Environment—Determination of Metabolic Rate	ISO	ISO 8996:2004
	Ergonomics of the Thermal Environment—Estimation of the Thermal Insulation and Water Vapour Resistance of a Clothing Ensemble	ISO	ISO 9920:2007
Commissioning	HVAC Quality Installation Specification	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	HVAC Quality Installation Verification Protocols	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 9 QIvp-2016
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Quality Installations	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	The Commissioning Process	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 0-2013
	HVAC&R Technical Requirements for the Commissioning Process	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 1.1-2007
	Commissioning Process for Buildings and Systems	ASHRAE	ASHRAE 202-2013
	Standard Practice for Building Enclosure Commissioning	ASTM	ASTM E2813-12
	HVAC Systems—Commissioning Manual, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2013
Compressors	Displacement Compressors, Vacuum Pumps and Blowers	ASME	ASME PTC 9-1970
	Performance Test Code on Compressors and Exhausters	ASME	ASME PTC 10-1997 (RA14)
	Compressed Air and Gas Handbook, 6th ed. (2003)	CAGI	CAGI
Refrigerant	Positive Displacement Condensing Units	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 520-2004
	Positive Displacement Refrigerant Compressors and Compressor Units	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 540-2004
	Safety Standard for Refrigeration Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 15-2022
	Methods for Performance Testing Positive Displacement Refrigerant Compressors and Condensing Units	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 23-2022
	Testing of Refrigerant Compressors	ISO	ISO 917:1989
	Refrigerant Compressors—Presentation of Performance Data	ISO	ISO 9309:1989

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Hermetic Refrigerant Motor-Compressors	UL/CSA	UL 984-1996/C22.2 No.140.2-96 (R2011)
Computers	Method of Testing for Rating Computer and Data Processing Room Unitary Air Conditioners	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 127-2020
	Method of Test for the Evaluation of Building Energy Analysis Computer Programs	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 140-2020
	Fire Protection of Information Technology Equipment	NFPA	NFPA 75-2013
Condensers	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Residential Equipment Selection, 2nd ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	Water-Cooled Refrigerant Condensers, Remote Type	AHRI	AHRI 450-2007
	Remote Mechanical-Draft Air-Cooled Refrigerant Condensers	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 460-2005
	Remote Mechanical Draft Evaporative Refrigerant Condensers	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 491-2011
	Safety Standard for Refrigeration Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 15-2022
	Methods of Testing for Rating Remote Mechanical-Draft Air-Cooled Refrigerant Condensers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 20-1997 (RA06)
	Methods of Testing for Rating Liquid Water-Cooled Refrigerant Condensers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 22-2023
	Methods for Performance Testing Positive Dipslacement Refrigerant Compressors and Condensing Units	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 23-2022
	Methods of Laboratory Testing Remote Mechanical-Draft Evaporative Refrigerant Condensers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 64-2020
	Steam Surface Condensers	ASME	ASME PTC 12.2-2010
	Standards for Steam Surface Condensers, 11th ed. (2012)	HEI	HEI 2629
	Standards for Direct Contact Barometric and Low Level Condensers, 8th ed. (2010)	HEI	HEI 2634
	Refrigerant-Containing Components and Accessories, Nonelectrical	UL	ANSI/UL 207-2009
Condensing Units	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Residential Equipment Selection, 2nd ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	Commercial and Industrial Unitary Air-Conditioning Condensing Units	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 366-2009
	Methods for Performance Testing Positive Dipslacement Refrigerant Compressors and Condensing Units	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 232022
	Heating and Cooling Equipment	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 1995-2011/C22.2 No. 236-11
Containers	Series 1 Freight Containers—Classifications, Dimensions, and Ratings	ISO	ISO 668:2013
	Series 1 Freight Containers—Specifications and Testing; Part 2: Thermal Containers	ISO	ISO 1496-2:2008
	Animal Environment in Cargo Compartments	SAE	SAE AIR1600B-2010
Controls	Temperature Control Systems (2002)	AABC	National Standards, Ch. 12
	Field Testing of HVAC Controls Components	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 11-2009
	Specifying Direct Digital Control Systems	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 13-2015
	BACnet™—A Data Communication Protocol for Building Automation and Control Networks	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 135-2020
	Method of Test for Conformance to BACnet®	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 135.1-2013
	Method of Test for Rating Air Terminal Unit Controls	ASHRAE	ASHRAE 195-2013
	Temperature-Indicating and Regulating Equipment	CSA	C22.2 No. 24-15
	Performance Requirements for Thermostats Used with Individual Room Electric Space Heating Devices	CSA	CAN/CSA C828-13
	Solid-State Controls for Appliances	UL	UL 244A-2003
	Limit Controls	UL	ANSI/UL 353-1994
	Primary Safety Controls for Gas- and Oil-Fired Appliances	UL	ANSI/UL 372-1994
	Temperature-Indicating and -Regulating Equipment	UL	UL 873-2007
	Tests for Safety-Related Controls Employing Solid-State Devices	UL	UL 991-2004
	Automatic Electrical Controls for Household and Similar Use; Part 1: General Requirements	UL	UL 60730-1-2009
Commercial and Industrial	Guidelines for Boiler Control Systems (Gas/Oil Fired Boilers) (1998)	ABMA	ABMA 301
	Guideline for the Integration of Boilers and Automated Control Systems in Heating Applications (1998)	ABMA	ABMA 306
	Industrial Control and Systems: General Requirements	NEMA	NEMA ICS 1-2000 (R2008)
	Preventive Maintenance of Industrial Control and Systems Equipment	NEMA	NEMA ICS 1.3-1986 (R2009)
	Industrial Control and Systems, Controllers, Contactors, and Overload Relays Rated Not More than 2000 Volts AC or 750 Volts DC	NEMA	NEMA ICS 2-2000 (R2005)
	Industrial Control and Systems: Instructions for the Handling, Installation, Operation and Maintenance of Motor Control Centers Rated Not More than 600 Volts	NEMA	NEMA ICS 2.3-1995 (R2008)
	Industrial Control Equipment	UL	ANSI/UL 508-2007
Residential	Manually Operated Gas Valves for Appliances, Appliance Connector Valves and Hose End Valves	CSA	ANSI Z21.15-2009/CSA 9.1-2009 (R2014)

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Gas Appliance Pressure Regulators	CSA	ANSI Z21.18-2007/CSA 6.3-2007 (R2012)
	Automatic Gas Ignition Systems and Components	CSA	ANSI Z21.20-2005
	Gas Appliance Thermostats	CSA	ANSI Z21.23-2010
	Manually-Operated Piezo-Electric Spark Gas Ignition Systems and Components	CSA	ANSI Z21.77-2005/CSA 6.23-2005 (R2011)
	Manually Operated Electric Gas Ignition Systems and Components	CSA	ANSI Z21.92-2001/CSA 6.29-2001 (R2012)
	Residential Controls—Electrical Wall-Mounted Room Thermostats	NEMA	NEMA DC 3-2013
	Residential Controls—Surface Type Controls for Electric Storage Water Heaters	NEMA	NEMA DC 5-1989 (R2008)
	Residential Controls—Temperature Limit Controls for Electric Baseboard Heaters	NEMA	NEMA DC 10-2009
	Residential Controls—Hot-Water Immersion Controls	NEMA	NEMA DC 12-1985 (R2013)
	Line-Voltage Integrally Mounted Thermostats for Electric Heaters	NEMA	NEMA DC 13-1979 (R2013)
	Residential Controls—Class 2 Transformers	NEMA	NEMA DC 20-1992 (R2009)
	Safety Guidelines for the Application, Installation, and Maintenance of Solid State Controls	NEMA	NEMA ICS 1.1-1984 (R2009)
	Electrical Quick-Connect Terminals	UL	ANSI/UL 310-2014
Coolers	Refrigeration Equipment	CSA	CAN/CSA-C22.2 No. 120-13
	Unit Coolers for Refrigeration	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 420-2008
	Quality Maintenance of Commercial Refrigeration Systems	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 14 QMref-2015
	Refrigeration Unit Coolers	UL	ANSI/UL 412-2011
Air	Methods of Testing Forced Convection and Natural Convection Air Coolers for Refrigeration	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 25-2001 (RA06)
Drinking Water	Methods of Testing for Rating Drinking-Water Coolers with Self-Contained Mechanical Refrigeration	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 18-2008 (RA13)
	Drinking-Water Coolers	UL	ANSI/UL 399-2008
	Drinking Water System Components—Health Effects	NSF	ANSI/NSF 61-2014
Evaporative	Method of Testing Direct Evaporative Air Coolers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 133-2024
	Method of Test for Rating Indirect Evaporative Coolers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 143-2015
Food and Beverage	Milking Machine Installations—Vocabulary	ASABE	ANSI/ASABE AD3918-2007 (R2011)
	Methods of Testing for Rating Vending Machines for Sealed Beverages	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 32.1-2022
	Methods of Testing for Rating Pre-Mix and Post-Mix Beverage Dispensing Equipment	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 32.2-2018 (RA22)
	Manual Food and Beverage Dispensing Equipment	NSF	ANSI/NSF 18-2012
	Commercial Bulk Milk Dispensing Equipment	NSF	ANSI/NSF 20-2012
	Refrigerated Vending Machines	UL	ANSI/UL 541-2011
Liquid	Refrigerant-Cooled Liquid Coolers, Remote Type	AHRI	AHRI 480-2007
	Methods of Testing for Rating Liquid Coolers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 24-2013
	Liquid Cooling Systems	SAE	SAE AIR1811A-1997 (R2010)
Cooling Towers	Cooling Tower Testing (2002)	AABC	National Standards, Ch 13
	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Bioaerosols: Assessment and Control (1999)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Atmospheric Water Cooling Equipment	ASME	ASME PTC 23-2003 (RA14)
	Water-Cooling Towers	NFPA	NFPA 214-2011
	Acceptance Test Code for Water-Cooling Towers	CTI	CTI ATC-105 (2000)
	Code for Measurement of Sound from Water Cooling Towers	CTI	CTI ATC-128 (2014)
	Nomenclature for Industrial Water Cooling Towers	CTI	CTI BUL-109 (1997)
	Recommended Practice for Airflow Testing of Cooling Towers	CTI	CTI PFM-143 (1994)
	Fiberglass-Reinforced Plastic Panels	CTI	CTI STD-131 (2009)
	Certification of Water Cooling Tower Thermal Performance	CTI	CTI STD-201RS (2013)
Crop Drying	Density, Specific Gravity, and Mass-Moisture Relationships of Grain for Storage	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE D241.4-1992 (R2012)
	Thermal Properties of Grain and Grain Products	ASABE	ASAE D243.4-2003 (R2012)
	Moisture Relationships of Plant-Based Agricultural Products	ASABE	ASAE D245.6-2007 (R2012)
	Dielectric Properties of Grain and Seed	ASABE	ASAE D293.4-2012
	Construction and Rating of Equipment for Drying Farm Crops	ASABE	ASAE S248.3-1976 (R2010)
	Resistance to Airflow of Grains, Seeds, Other Agricultural Products, and Perforated Metal Sheets	ASABE	ASAE D272.3-1996 (R2011)
	Shelled Corn Storage Time for 0.5% Dry Matter Loss	ASABE	ASAE D535-2005 (R2010)
	Moisture Measurement—Unground Grain and Seeds	ASABE	ASAE S352.2-1998 (R2012)
	Moisture Measurement—Meat and Meat Products	ASABE	ASAE S353-1972 (R2012)
	Moisture Measurement—Forages	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE S358.3-2012
	Moisture Measurement—Peanuts	ASABE	ASAE S410.2-2010
	Thin-Layer Drying of Agricultural Crops	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE S448.1-2001 (R2012)
	Moisture Measurement—Tobacco	ASABE	ASAE S487-1987 (R2012)

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Energy Efficiency of Peanut Drying Systems	ASABE	ASAE S488.1-2013
	Temperature Sensor Locations for Seed-Cotton Drying Systems	ASABE	ASAE S530.1-2007 (R2012)
Dampers	Laboratory Methods of Testing Dampers for Rating	AMCA	AMCA 500-D-07
	Selecting Outdoor, Return, and Relief Dampers for Air-Side Economizer Systems	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 16-2014
Dehumidifiers	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Bioaerosols: Assessment and Control (1999)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Dehumidifiers	AHAM	ANSI/AHAM DH-1-2008
	Method of Testing for Rating Desiccant Dehumidifiers Utilizing Heat for the Regeneration Process	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 139-2022
	Criteria for Moisture-Control Design Analysis in Buildings	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 160-2021
	Method of Test for Rating Desiccant-Based Dehumidification Equipment	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 174-2022
	Method of Testing for Rating Indoor Pool Dehumidifiers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 190-2013
	Method of Testing for Rating DX-Dedicated Outdoor Air Systems for Moisture Removal Capacity and Moisture Removal Efficiency	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 198-2013
	Moisture Separator Reheaters	ASME	PTC 12.4-1992 (RA14)
	Dehumidifiers	CSA	C22.2 No. 92-1971 (R2013)
	Performance of Dehumidifiers	CSA	CAN/CSA-C749-07 (R2012)
	Dehumidifiers	UL	ANSI/UL 474-2009
Desiccants	Method of Testing Desiccants for Refrigerant Drying	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 35-2014
Driers	Liquid-Line Driers	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 711-2009
	Method of Testing Liquid Line Refrigerant Driers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 63.1-1995 (RA01)
	Refrigerant-Containing Components and Accessories, Nonelectrical	UL	ANSI/UL 207-2009
Ducts and Fittings	Hose, Air Duct, Flexible Nonmetallic, Aircraft	SAE	SAE AS1501C-1994 (R2013)
	Ducted Electric Heat Guide for Air Handling Systems, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 1994
	Factory-Made Air Ducts and Air Connectors	UL	ANSI/UL 181-2013
Construction	Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice, 29th ed. (2016)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Preferred Metric Sizes for Flat, Round, Square, Rectangular, and Hexagonal Metal Products	ASME	ASME B32.100-2005
	Sheet Metal Welding Code	AWS	AWS D9.1M/D9.1:2012
	Fibrous Glass Duct Construction Standards, 5th ed.	NAIMA	NAIMA AH116
	Residential Fibrous Glass Duct Construction Standards, 3rd ed.	NAIMA	NAIMA AH119
	Thermoplastic Duct (PVC) Construction Manual, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 1995
	Accepted Industry Practices for Sheet Metal Lagging, 1st ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2002
	Fibrous Glass Duct Construction Standards, 7th ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2003
	Round Industrial Duct Construction Standards, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 1999
	Rectangular Industrial Duct Construction Standards, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2007
Installation	Flexible Duct Performance and Installation Standards, 5th ed.	ADC	ADC-91
	HVAC Quality Installation Specification	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	HVAC Quality Installation Verification Protocols	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 9 QIvp-2016
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Duct Diagnostics and Repair	ACCA	ACCA 2016
	Installation of Air-Conditioning and Ventilating Systems	NFPA	NFPA 90A-2015
	Installation of Warm Air Heating and Air-Conditioning Systems	NFPA	NFPA 90B-2015
Material Specifications	Specification for General Requirements for Flat-Rolled Stainless and Heat-Resisting Steel Plate, Sheet and Strip	ASTM	ASTM A480/A480M-14b
	Specification for Steel, Sheet, Carbon, Structural, and High-Strength, Low-Alloy, Hot-Rolled and Cold-Rolled, General Requirements for	ASTM	ASTM A568/A568M-14
	Specification for Steel Sheet, Zinc-Coated (Galvanized) or Zinc-Iron Alloy-Coated (Galvannealed) by the Hot-Dipped Process	ASTM	ASTM A653/A653M-13
	Specification for General Requirements for Steel Sheet, Metallic-Coated by the Hot-Dip Process	ASTM	ASTM A924/A924M-14
	Specification for Steel, Sheet, Cold-Rolled, Carbon, Structural, High-Strength Low-Alloy, High-Strength Low-Alloy with Improved Formability, Solution Hardened, and Bake Hardenable	ASTM	ASTM A1008/A1008M-13
	Specification for Steel, Sheet and Strip, Hot-Rolled, Carbon, Structural, High-Strength Low-Alloy, High-Strength Low-Alloy with Improved Formability, and Ultra-High Strength	ASTM	ASTM A1011/A1011M-14
	Practice for Measuring Flatness Characteristics of Coated Sheet Products	ASTM	ASTM A1030/A1030M-11
System Design	Installation Techniques for Perimeter Heating and Cooling	ACCA	ACCA Manual 4-1990
	Residential Duct Systems	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA Manual D-2016
	Commercial Low Pressure, Low Velocity Duct System Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual Q-1990
	Air Distribution Basics for Residential and Small Commercial Buildings	ACCA	ACCA Manual T-2001
	Method of Test for Determining the Design and Seasonal Efficiencies of Residential Thermal Distribution Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 152-2014
	Closure Systems for Use with Rigid Air Ducts	UL	ANSI/UL 181A-2013

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Closure Systems for Use with Flexible Air Ducts and Air Connectors	UL	ANSI/UL 181B-2013
Testing	Duct Leakage Testing (2002)	AABC	National Standards, Ch 5
	Balancing and Testing Air and Hydronic Systems	ACCA	ACCA Manual B 2009
	HVAC Quality Installation Specification	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	HVAC Quality Installation Verification Protocols	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 9 QIvp-2016
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Quality Installations	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Duct Diagnostics and Repair	ACCA	ACCA 2016
	Flexible Air Duct Test Code, 3rd ed.	ADC	ADC FD 72-R1
	Test Method for Measuring Acoustical and Airflow Performance of Duct Liner Materials and Prefabricated Silencers	ASTM	ASTM E477-13
	Method of Testing to Determine Flow Resistance of HVAC Ducts and Fittings	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 120-2022
	Method of Testing HVAC Air Ducts	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE/SMACNA 126-2016
	HVAC Air Duct Leakage Test Manual, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2012
	HVAC Duct Systems Inspection Guide, 3rd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2006
Economizers	Selecting Outdoor, Return, and Relief Dampers for Air-Side Economizer Systems	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 16-2014
Electrical	Electrical Power Systems and Equipment—Voltage Ratings	ANSI	ANSI C84.1-2011
	Test Method for Bond Strength of Electrical Insulating Varnishes by the Helical Coil Test	ASTM	ASTM D2519-07 (2012)
	Standard Specification for Shelter, Electrical Equipment, Lightweight	ASTM	ASTM E2377-10
	Canadian Electrical Code, Part I (22nd ed.), Safety Standard for Electrical Installations	CSA	CSA C22.1-12
	Part II—General Requirements	CSA	CAN/CSA-C22.2 No. 0-10
	ICC Electrical Code, Administrative Provisions (2006)	ICC	ICCEC
	Low Voltage Cartridge Fuses	NEMA	NEMA FU 1-2012
	Industrial Control and Systems: Terminal Blocks	NEMA	NEMA ICS 4-2010
	Industrial Control and Systems: Enclosures	NEMA	ANSI/NEMA ICS 6-1993 (R2006)
	Application Guide for Ground Fault Protective Devices for Equipment	NEMA	ANSI/NEMA PB 2.2-2014
	General Color Requirements for Wiring Devices	NEMA	NEMA WD 1-1999 (R2010)
	Wiring Devices—Dimensional Specifications	NEMA	ANSI/NEMA WD 6-2012
	National Electrical Code®	NFPA	NFPA 70-2014
	National Fire Alarm and Signaling Code	NFPA	NFPA 72-2013
	Compatibility of Electrical Connectors and Wiring	SAE	SAE AIR1329-2014
	Molded-Case Circuit Breakers, Molded-Case Switches, and Circuit-Breaker Enclosures	UL	ANSI/UL 489-2013
Energy	Air-Conditioning and Refrigerating Equipment Nameplate Voltages	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 110-2012
	Comfort, Air Quality, and Efficiency by Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual RS-1997
	Thermal Energy Storage	ACCA	ACCA 2005
	Measurement of Energy and Demand Savings	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 14-2014
	Energy Standard for Buildings Except Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE/IES 90.1-2022
	Energy-Efficient Design of Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE/IES 90.2-2007
	Energy Conservation in Existing Buildings	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE/IES 100-2024
	Methods of Determining, Expressing, and Comparing Building Energy Performance and Greenhouse Gas Emissions	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 105-2014
	Method of Test for the Evaluation of Building Energy Analysis Computer Programs	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 140-2020
	Method of Test for Determining the Design and Seasonal Efficiencies of Residential Thermal Distribution Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 152-2014
	Standard for the Design of High-Performance, Green Buildings Except Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE/ USGBC	ANSI/ASHRAE/USGBC/IES 189.1-2023
	National Green Building Standard	ICC/ ASHRAE	ICC/ASHRAE 700-2015
	Fuel Cell Power Systems Performance	ASME	PTC 50-2002 (RA14)
	International Energy Conservation Code® (2015)	ICC	IECC
	International Green Construction Code™ (2012)	ICC	IGCC
	Uniform Solar Energy Code (2012)	IAPMO	IAPMO
	Energy Management Guide for Selection and Use of Fixed Frequency Medium AC Squirrel-Cage Polyphase Induction Motors	NEMA	NEMA MG 10-2013
	Energy Management Guide for Selection and Use of Single-Phase Motors	NEMA	NEMA MG 11-1977 (R2012)
	HVAC Systems—Commissioning Manual, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2013
	Building Systems Analysis and Retrofit Manual, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2011
	Energy Systems Analysis and Management, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2014
	Energy Management Equipment	UL	UL 916-2007
Exhaust Systems	Fan Systems: Supply/Return/Relief/Exhaust (2002)	AABC	National Standards, Ch 10
	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice, 29th ed. (2016)	ACGIH	ACGIH

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Fundamentals Governing the Design and Operation of Local Exhaust Ventilation Systems	AIHA	ANSI/AIHA Z9.2-2012
	Spray Finishing Operations: Safety Code for Design, Construction, and Ventilation	AIHA	ANSI/AIHA Z9.3-2007
	Laboratory Ventilation	AIHA	ANSI/AIHA Z9.5-2012
	Recirculation of Air from Industrial Process Exhaust Systems	AIHA	ANSI/AIHA Z9.7-2007
	Method of Testing Performance of Laboratory Fume Hoods	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 110-2016
	Ventilation for Commercial Cooking Operations	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 154-2016
	Performance Test Code on Compressors and Exhausters	ASME	PTC 10-1997 (RA14)
	Flue and Exhaust Gas Analyses	ASME	PTC 19.10-1981
	Mechanical Flue-Gas Exhausters	CSA	CAN B255-M81 (R2005)
	Exhaust Systems for Air Conveying of Vapors, Gases, Mists, and Particulate Solids	NFPA	ANSI/NFPA 91-2015
	Draft Equipment	UL	UL 378-2006
Expansion Valves	Thermostatic Refrigerant Expansion Valves	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 750-2007
	Method of Testing Capacity of Thermostatic Refrigerant Expansion Valves	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 17-2022
Fan-Coil Units	Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice, 29th ed. (2016)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Room Fan-Coils	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 440-2008
	Methods of Testing for Rating Fan-Coil Conditioners	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 79-2015
	Heating and Cooling Equipment	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 1995-2011/C22.2 No. 236-11
Fans	Residential Duct Systems	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 1 Manual D-2016
	Commercial Low Pressure, Low Velocity Duct System Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual Q-2003
	Balancing and Testing Air and Hydronic Systems	ACCA	ACCA Manual B-2009
	HVAC Quality Installation Specifications	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Quality Installations	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice, 29th ed. (2016)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Standards Handbook	AMCA	AMCA 99-10
	Air Systems	AMCA	AMCA 200-95 (R2011)
	Fans and Systems	AMCA	AMCA 201-02 (R2011)
	Troubleshooting	AMCA	AMCA 202-98 (R2011)
	Field Performance Measurement of Fan Systems	AMCA	AMCA 203-90 (R2011)
	Balance Quality and Vibration Levels for Fans	AMCA	ANSI/AMCA 204-05 (R2012)
	Laboratory Methods of Testing Air Circulator Fans for Rating and Certification	AMCA	ANSI/AMCA 230-12
	Laboratory Method of Testing Positive Pressure Ventilators for Rating	AMCA	ANSI/AMCA 240-06
	Reverberant Room Method for Sound Testing of Fans	AMCA	AMCA 300-08
	Methods for Calculating Fan Sound Ratings from Laboratory Test Data	AMCA	AMCA 301-90
	Application of Sone Ratings for Non-Ducted Air Moving Devices	AMCA	AMCA 302-73 (R2012)
	Application of Sound Power Level Ratings for Fans	AMCA	AMCA 303-79 (R2012)
	Recommended Safety Practices for Users and Installers of Industrial and Commercial Fans	AMCA	AMCA 410-96
	Industrial Process/Power Generation Fans: Site Performance Test Standard	AMCA	AMCA 803-02 (R2008)
	Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 12 QH-2014
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Mechanical Balance of Fans and Blowers	AHRI	AHRI *Guideline* G-2011
	Acoustics—Measurement of Airborne Noise Emitted and Structure-Borne Vibration Induced by Small Air-Moving Devices—Part 1: Airborne Noise Measurement	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.11-2013-Part 1/ISO 103021:2013
	Part 2: Structure-Borne Vibration	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.11-2013-Part 2/ISO 10302-2:2013
	Laboratory Methods of Testing Fans for Aerodynamic Performance Rating	ASHRAE/ AMCA	ANSI/ASHRAE 51-2016 ANSI/AMCA 210-16
	Laboratory Methods of Testing Fans Used to Exhaust Smoke in Smoke Management Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 149-2013
	Ventilation for Commercial Cooking Operations	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 154-2016
	Fans	ASME	ANSI/ASME PTC 11-2008
	Fans and Ventilators	CSA	C22.2 No. 113-12
	Energy Performance of Ceiling Fans	CSA	CAN/CSA-C814-10
	Residential Mechanical Ventilating Systems	CSA	CAN/CSA-F326-M91 (R2010)
	Electric Fans	UL	ANSI/UL 507-1999
	Power Ventilators	UL	ANSI/UL 705-2004
Fenestration	Practice for Calculation of Photometric Transmittance and Reflectance of Materials to Solar Radiation	ASTM	ASTM E971-11
	Test Method for Solar Photometric Transmittance of Sheet Materials Using Sunlight	ASTM	ASTM E972-96 (2013)
	Test Method for Solar Transmittance (Terrestrial) of Sheet Materials Using Sunlight	ASTM	ASTM E1084-86 (2009)
	Practice for Determining Load Resistance of Glass in Buildings	ASTM	ASTM E1300-12ae1
	Practice for Installation of Exterior Windows, Doors and Skylights	ASTM	ASTM E2112-07
	Test Method for Insulating Glass Unit Performance	ASTM	ASTM E2188-10

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	Test Method for Testing Resistance to Fogging Insulating Glass Units	ASTM	ASTM E2189-10e1
	Specification for Insulating Glass Unit Performance and Evaluation	ASTM	ASTM E2190-10
	Guide for Assessing the Durability of Absorptive Electrochemical Coatings within Sealed Insulating Glass Units	ASTM	ASTM E2354-10
	Tables for Reference Solar Spectral Irradiance: Direct Normal and Hemispherical on 37° Tilted Surface	ASTM	ASTM G173-03 (2012)
	Windows	CSA	CSA A440-00 (R2005)
	Fenestration Energy Performance	CSA	CSA A440.2-14
	Window, Door, and Skylight Installation	CSA	CSA A440.4-07 (R2012)
Filter-Driers	Flow-Capacity Rating of Suction-Line Filters and Suction-Line Filter-Driers	AHRI	AHRI 731-2013
	Method of Testing Liquid Line Filter-Drier Filtration Capability	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 63.2-2024
	Method of Testing Flow Capacity of Suction Line Filters and Filter-Driers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 78-1985 (RA07)
Fireplaces	Factory-Built Fireplaces	UL	ANSI/UL 127-2011
	Fireplace Stoves	UL	ANSI/UL 737-2011
Fire Protection	Test Method for Surface Burning Characteristics of Building Materials	ASTM/NFPA	ASTM E84-14
	Test Methods for Fire Test of Building Construction and Materials	ASTM	ASTM E119-14
	Test Method for Room Fire Test of Wall and Ceiling Materials and Assemblies	ASTM	ASTM E2257-13a
	Test Method for Determining Fire Resistance of Perimeter Fire Barriers Using Intermediate-Scale Multi-Story Test Apparatus	ASTM	ASTM E2307-15
	Guide for Laboratory Monitors	ASTM	ASTM E2335-12
	Test Method for Fire Resistance Grease Duct Enclosure Systems	ASTM	ASTM E2336-14
	Practice for Specimen Preparation and Mounting of Paper or Vinyl Wall Coverings to Assess Surface Burning Characteristics	ASTM	ASTM E2404-13e1
	BOCA National Fire Prevention Code, 11th ed. (1999)	BOCA	BNFPC
	Uniform Fire Code	IFCI	UFC 1997
	International Fire Code® (2015)	ICC	IFC
	International Mechanical Code® (2015)	ICC	IMC
	International Urban-Wildland Interface Code® (2012)	ICC	IUWIC
	Fire-Resistance Tests—Elements of Building Construction; Part 1: Gen. Requirements	ISO	ISO 834-1:1999
	Fire-Resistance Tests—Door and Shutter Assemblies	ISO	ISO 3008:2007
	Reaction to Fire Tests—Ignitability of Building Products Using a Radiant Heat Source	ISO	ISO 5657:1997
	Fire Containment—Elements of Building Construction—Part 1: Ventilation Ducts	ISO	ISO 6944-1:2008
	Fire Service Annunciator and Interface	NEMA	NEMA SB 30-2005
	Fire Protection Handbook (2008)	NFPA	NFPA
	National Fire Codes® (issued annually)	NFPA	NFPA
	Fire Protection Guide to Hazardous Materials	NFPA	NFPA HAZ-2010
	Fire Code	NFPA	NFPA 1-2015
	Installation of Sprinkler Systems	NFPA	NFPA 13-2013
	Flammable and Combustible Liquids Code	NFPA	NFPA 30-2015
	Fire Protection for Laboratories Using Chemicals	NFPA	NFPA 45-2015
	National Fire Alarm Code	NFPA	NFPA 72-2013
	Fire Doors and Other Opening Protectives	NFPA	NFPA 80-2013
	Health Care Facilities	NFPA	NFPA 99-2015
	Life Safety Code®	NFPA	NFPA 101-2015
	Methods of Fire Tests of Door Assemblies	NFPA	NFPA 252-2012
	Fire, Smoke and Radiation Damper Installation Guide for HVAC Systems, 5th ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2002
	Fire Tests of Door Assemblies	UL	ANSI/UL 10B-2008
	Heat Responsive Links for Fire-Protection Service	UL	ANSI/UL 33-2010
	Fire Tests of Building Construction and Materials	UL	ANSI/UL 263-2011
	Fire Dampers	UL	ANSI/UL 555-2006
	Fire Tests of Through-Penetration Firestops	UL	ANSI/UL 1479-2003
Smoke Management	The Commissioning Process for Smoke Control Systems	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 1.5-2012
	Laboratory Methods of Testing Fans Used to Exhaust Smoke in Smoke Management Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 149-2013
	Smoke-Control Systems Utilizing Barriers and Pressure Differences	NFPA	NFPA 92A-2009
	Smoke Management Systems in Malls, Atria, and Large Spaces	NFPA	NFPA 92B-2009
	Ceiling Dampers	UL	ANSI/UL 555C-2014
	Smoke Dampers	UL	ANSI/UL 555S-2014
Freezers	Quality Maintenance of Commercial Refrigeration Systems	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 14 QMref-2015
	Energy Performance and Capacity of Household Refrigerators, Refrigerator-Freezers, Freezers, and Wine Chillers	CSA	C300-12
	Energy Performance of Food Service Refrigerators and Freezers	CSA	C827-10

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Refrigeration Equipment	CSA	CAN/CSA-C22.2 No. 120-13
Commercial	Dispensing Freezers	NSF	ANSI/NSF 6-2012
	Commercial Refrigerators and Freezers	NSF	ANSI/NSF 7-2014
	Commercial Refrigerators and Freezers	UL	ANSI/UL 471-2010
	Ice Makers	UL	ANSI/UL 563-2009
	Ice Cream Makers	UL	ANSI/UL 621-2010
Household	Refrigerators, Refrigerator-Freezers and Freezers	AHAM	ANSI/AHAM HRF-1-2008
	Household Refrigerators and Freezers	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 250-1993/C22.2 No. 63-93 (R2013)
Fuels	Threshold Limit Values for Chemical Substances (updated annually)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	National Gas Fuel Code	NFPA	ANSI Z223.1/NPFA 54-2015
	Reporting of Fuel Properties when Testing Diesel Engines with Alternative Fuels Derived from Plant Oils and Animal Fats	ASABE	ASABE EP552.1-2009
	Coal Pulverizers	ASME	PTC 4.2 1969 (RA09)
	Classification of Coals by Rank	ASTM	ASTM D388-12
	Specification for Fuel Oils	ASTM	ASTM D396-15
	Specification for Diesel Fuel Oils	ASTM	ASTM D975-14b
	Specification for Gas Turbine Fuel Oils	ASTM	ASTM D2880-14a
	Specification for Kerosine	ASTM	ASTM D3699-13be1
	Practice for Receipt, Storage and Handling of Fuels	ASTM	ASTM D4418-00 (2011)
	Test Method for Determination of Yield Stress and Apparent Viscosity of Used Engine Oils at Low Temperature	ASTM	ASTM D6896-14
	Test Method for Total Sulfur in Naphthas, Distillates, Reformulated Gasolines, Diesels, Biodiesels, and Motor Fuels by Oxidative Combustion and Electrochemical Detection	ASTM	ASTM D6920-13
	Test Method for Determination of Homogeneity and Miscibility in Automotive Engine Oils	ASTM	ASTM D6922-13
	Test Method for Measurement of Hindered Phenolic and Aromatic Amine Antioxidant Content in Non-Zinc Turbine Oils by Linear Sweep Voltammetry	ASTM	ASTM D6971-09 (2014)
	Practice for Enumeration of Viable Bacteria and Fungi in Liquid Fuels—Filtration and Culture Procedures	ASTM	ASTM D6974-09 (2013)e2
	Test Method for Evaluation of Automotive Engine Oils in the Sequence IIIF, Spark-Ignition Engine	ASTM	ASTM D6984-14a
	Test Method for Determination of Ignition Delay and Derived Cetane Number (DCN) of Diesel Fuel Oils by Combustion in a Constant Volume Chamber	ASTM	ASTM D6890-13be1
	Test Method for Determination of Total Sulfur in Light Hydrocarbon, Motor Fuels, and Oils by Online Gas Chromatography with Flame Photometric Detection	ASTM	ASTM D7041-04 (2010)e1
	Test Method for Sulfur in Gasoline, Diesel Fuel, Jet Fuel, Kerosine, Biodiesel, Biodiesel Blends, and Gasoline-Ethanol Blends by Monochromatic Wavelength Dispersive X-Ray Fluorescence Spectrometry	ASTM	ASTM D7039-13
	Test Method for Flash Point by Modified Continuously Closed Cup (MCCCFP) Tester	ASTM	ASTM D7094-12e1
	Test Method for Determining the Viscosity-Temperature Relationship of Used and Soot-Containing Engine Oils at Low Temperatures	ASTM	ASTM D7110-14
	Test Method for Determination of Trace Elements in Middle Distillate Fuels by Inductively Coupled Plasma Atomic Emission Spectrometry (ICP-AES)	ASTM	ASTM D7111-14
	Test Method for Determining Stability and Compatibility of Heavy Fuel Oils and Crude Oils by Heavy Fuel Oil Stability Analyzer (Optical Detection)	ASTM	ASTM D7112-12
	Test Method for Determination of Intrinsic Stability of Asphaltene-Containing Residues, Heavy Fuel Oils, and Crude Oils (*n*-Heptane Phase Separation; Optical Detection)	ASTM	ASTM D7157-12
	Test Method for Hydrogen Content of Middle Distillate Petroleum Products by Low-Resolution Pulsed Nuclear Magnetic Resonance Spectroscopy	ASTM	ASTM D7171-05 (2011)
	Gas-Fired Central Furnaces	CSA	ANSI Z21.47-2012/CSA 2.3-2012
	Gas Unit Heaters, Gas Packaged Heaters, Gas Utility Heaters and Gas-Fired Duct Furnaces	CSA	ANSI Z83.8-2013/CSA-2.6-2013
	Industrial and Commercial Gas-Fired Package Furnaces	CSA	CGA 3.2-1976 (R2009)
	Uniform Mechanical Code (2012)	IAPMO	Chapter 13
	Uniform Plumbing Code (2012)	IAPMO	Chapter 12
	International Fuel Gas Code® (2015)	ICC	IFGC
	Standard Gas Code (1999)	SBCCI	SGC
	Commercial-Industrial Gas Heating Equipment (2011)	UL	UL 795-2011
Furnaces	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Residential Equipment Selection, 2nd ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	HVAC Quality Installation Specification	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Quality Installations	ACCA	ACCA 2015

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Method of Testing for Annual Fuel Utilization Efficiency of Residential Central Furnaces and Boilers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 103-2022
	Prevention of Furnace Explosions/Implosions in Multiple Burner Boilers	NFPA	NFPA 8502-99
	Residential Gas Detectors	UL	ANSI/UL 1484-2000
	Heating and Cooling Equipment	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 1995-2011/C22.2 No. 236-11
	Single and Multiple Station Carbon Monoxide Alarms	UL	ANSI/UL 2034-2008
Gas	National Fuel Gas Code	AGA/NFPA	ANSI Z223.1/NFPA 54-2015
	Gas-Fired Central Furnaces	CSA	ANSI Z21.47-2012/CSA 2.3-2012
	Gas Unit Heaters, Gas Packaged Heaters, Gas Utility Heaters and Gas-Fired Duct Furnaces	CSA	ANSI Z83.8-2013/CSA-2.6-2013
	Industrial and Commercial Gas-Fired Package Furnaces	CSA	CGA 3.2-1976 (R2009)
	International Fuel Gas Code® (2015)	ICC	IFGC
	Standard Gas Code (1999)	SBCCI	SGC
	Commercial-Industrial Gas Heating Equipment	UL	UL 795-2011
Oil	Specification for Fuel Oils	ASTM	ASTM D396-15
	Specification for Diesel Fuel Oils	ASTM	ASTM D975-14b
	Test Method for Smoke Density in Flue Gases from Burning Distillate Fuels	ASTM	ASTM D2156-09 (2013)
	Standard Test Method for Vapor Pressure of Liquefied Petroleum Gases (LPG) (Expansion Method)	ASTM	ASTM D6897-09
	Oil Burning Stoves and Water Heaters	CSA	B140.3-1962 (R2011)
	Oil-Fired Warm Air Furnaces	CSA	B140.4-04 (R2009)
	Installation of Oil-Burning Equipment	NFPA	NFPA 31-2011
	Oil-Fired Central Furnaces	UL	UL 727-2006
	Oil-Fired Floor Furnaces	UL	ANSI/UL 729-2003
	Oil-Fired Wall Furnaces	UL	ANSI/UL 730-2003
Solid Fuel	Installation Code for Solid-Fuel-Burning Appliances and Equipment	CSA	CSA B365-10
	Solid-Fuel-Fired Central Heating Appliances	CSA	CAN/CSA-B366.1-11
	Solid-Fuel and Combination-Fuel Central and Supplementary Furnaces	UL	ANSI/UL 391-2010
Green Buildings	Standard for the Design of High-Performance, Green Buildings Except Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE/ USGBC	ANSI/ASHRAE/USGBC/IES 189.1-2023
	National Green Building Standard	ICC/ ASHRAE	ICC/ASHRAE 700-2015
	International Green Construction Code™ (2012)	ICC	IGCC
	Building Systems Analysis and Retrofit Manual, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2011
Heaters	Gas-Fired High-Intensity Infrared Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z83.19-2009/CSA 2.35-2009
	Gas-Fired Low-Intensity Infrared Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z83.20-2008/CSA 2.34-2008 (R2013)
	Threshold Limit Values for Chemical Substances (updated annually)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice, 29th ed. (2016)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Thermal Performance Testing of Solar Ambient Air Heaters	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE S423-1991 (R2012)
	Air Heaters	ASME	ASME PTC 4.3-1968 (RA91)
	Guide for Construction of Solid Fuel Burning Masonry Heaters	ASTM	ASTM E1602-03 (2010)e1
	Non-Recirculating Direct Gas-Fired Industrial Air Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z83.4-2013/CSA 3.7-2013
	Electric Duct Heaters	CSA	C22.2 No. 155-M1986 (R2013)
	Portable Kerosene-Fired Heaters	CSA	CAN3-B140.9.3-M86 (R2011)
	Standards for Closed Feedwater Heaters, 8th ed. (2009)	HEI	HEI 2622
	Electric Heating Appliances	UL	ANSI/UL 499-2014
	Electric Oil Heaters	UL	ANSI/UL 574-2003
	Oil-Fired Air Heaters and Direct-Fired Heaters	UL	UL 733-1993
	Electric Dry Bath Heaters	UL	ANSI/UL 875-2009
	Oil-Burning Stoves	UL	ANSI/UL 896-1993
Engine	Electric Engine Preheaters and Battery Warmers for Diesel Engines	SAE	SAE J1310-2011
	Selection and Application Guidelines for Diesel, Gasoline, and Propane Fired Liquid Cooled Engine Pre-Heaters	SAE	SAE J1350-2011
	Fuel Warmer—Diesel Engines	SAE	SAE J1422-2011
Nonresidential	Installation of Electric Infrared Brooding Equipment	ASABE	ASAE EP258.4-2014
	Gas-Fired Construction Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z83.7-2011/CSA 2.14-2011
	Recirculating Direct Gas-Fired Industrial Air Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z83.18-2015
	Portable Industrial Oil-Fired Heaters	CSA	B140.8-1967 (R2011)
	Fuel-Fired Heaters—Air Heating—for Construction and Industrial Machinery	SAE	SAE J1024-2011
	Commercial-Industrial Gas Heating Equipment	UL	UL 795-2011
	Electric Heaters for Use in Hazardous (Classified) Locations	UL	ANSI/UL 823-2006

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
Pool	HVAC Design for Swimming Pools and Spas	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 10 SPS-2010
	Methods of Testing and Rating Pool Heaters	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 146-2011
	Gas-Fired Pool Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z21.56-2014/CSA 4.7-2014
	Oil-Fired Service Water Heaters and Swimming Pool Heaters	CSA	B140.12-03 (R2013)
Room	Specification for Room Heaters, Pellet Fuel-Burning Type	ASTM	ASTM E1509-12
	Gas-Fired Room Heaters, Vol. II, Unvented Room Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z21.11.2-2013
	Gas-Fired Unvented Catalytic Room Heaters for Use with Liquefied Petroleum (LP) Gases	CSA	ANSI Z21.76-1994 (R2006)
	Vented Gas-Fired Space Heating Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.86-2008/CSA 2.32-2008 (R2014)
	Vented Gas Fireplace Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z21.88-2014/CSA 2.33-2014
	Unvented Kerosene-Fired Room Heaters and Portable Heaters	UL	UL 647-1993
	Movable and Wall- or Ceiling-Hung Electric Room Heaters	UL	UL 1278-2014
	Fixed and Location-Dedicated Electric Room Heaters	UL	UL 2021-2013
	Solid Fuel-Type Room Heaters	UL	ANSI/UL 1482-2011
Transport	Heater, Airplane, Engine Exhaust Gas to Air Heat Exchanger Type	SAE	SAE ARP86-2011
	Heater, Aircraft Internal Combustion Heat Exchanger Type	SAE	SAE AS8040B-2013
	Motor Vehicle Heater Test Procedure	SAE	SAE J638-2011
Unit	Gas Unit Heaters, Gas Packaged Heaters, Gas Utility Heaters and Gas-Fired Duct Furnaces	CSA	ANSI Z83.8-2013/CSA-2.6-2013
	Oil-Fired Unit Heaters	UL	ANSI/UL 731-1995
Heat Exchangers	Remote Mechanical-Draft Evaporative Refrigerant Condensers	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 491-2011
	Method of Testing Air-to-Air Heat/Energy Exchangers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 84-2020
	Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code—Section VIII, Division 1: Pressure Vessels	ASME	ASME BPVC-2015
	Single Phase Heat Exchangers	ASME	ASME PTC 12.5-2000 (RA05)
	Air Cooled Heat Exchangers	ASME	ASME PTC 30-1991 (RA11)
	Laboratory Methods of Test for Rating the Performance of Heat/Energy-Recovery Ventilators	CSA	C439-09 (R2014)
	Standards for Gasketed Plate Heat Exchangers, 1st ed.	HEI	HEI
	Standards for Shell and Tube Heat Exchangers, 5th ed. (2013)	HEI	HEI 2623
	Standards of Tubular Exchanger Manufacturers Association, 9th ed. (2007)	TEMA	TEMA
	Refrigerant-Containing Components and Accessories, Nonelectrical	UL	ANSI/UL 207-2009
Heating	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	HVAC Quality Installation Specification	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 5 QI-2015
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Quality Installations	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Residential Load Calculations	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 2 Manual J-2016
	Comfort, Air Quality, and Efficiency by Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual RS-1997
	Residential Equipment Selection, 2nd ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	Heating, Ventilating and Cooling Greenhouses	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE EP406.4-2003 (R2008)
	Peak Cooling and Heating Load Calculations in Buildings Except Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE/ ACCA	ANSI/ASHRAE/ACCA 183-2024
	Heater Elements	CSA	C22.2 No. 72-10 (R2014)
	Determining the Required Capacity of Residential Space Heating and Cooling Appliances	CSA	CAN/CSA-F280-12
	Heat Loss Calculation Guide (2001)	HYDI	HYDI H-22
	Residential Hydronic Heating Installation Design Guide	HYDI	IBR Guide
	Radiant Floor Heating (1995)	HYDI	HYDI 004
	Advanced Installation Guide (Commercial) for Hot Water Heating Systems (2001)	HYDI	HYDI 250
	Environmental Systems Technology, 2nd ed. (1999)	NEBB	NEBB
	Pulverized Fuel Systems	NFPA	NFPA 8503-97
	Aircraft Electrical Heating Systems	SAE	SAE AIR860B-2011
	Heating Value of Fuels	SAE	SAE J1498-2011
	Performance Test for Air-Conditioned, Heated, and Ventilated Off-Road Self-Propelled Work Machines	SAE	SAE J1503-2004
	HVAC Systems Applications, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2010
	Electric Baseboard Heating Equipment	UL	ANSI/UL 1042-2009
	Electric Duct Heaters	UL	ANSI/UL 1996-2009
	Heating and Cooling Equipment	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 1995-2011/C22.2 No. 236-11
Heat Pumps	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Geothermal Heat Pump Training Certification Program	ACCA	ACCA Training Manual
	Heat Pumps Systems, Principles and Applications, 2nd ed.	ACCA	ACCA Manual H-1984
	Residential Equipment Selection, 2nd ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice, 29th ed. (2016)	ACGIH	ACGIH

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Performance Rating of Unitary Air-Conditioning and Air-Source Heat Pump Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 210/240-2008
	Commercial and Industrial Unitary Air-Conditioning and Heat Pump Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 340/360-2007
	Single Package Vertical Air-Conditioner and Heat Humps	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 390-2003
	Direct Geoexchange Heat Pumps	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 870-2005
	Variable Refrigerant Flow (VRF) Multi-Split Air-Conditioning and Heat Pump Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 1230-2010
	Methods of Testing for Rating Electrically Driven Unitary Air-Conditioning and Heat Pump Equipment	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 37-2009
	Methods of Testing for Rating Seasonal Efficiency of Unitary Air-Conditioners and Heat Pumps	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 116-2010
	Method of Test for Direct-Expansion Ground Source Heat Pumps	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 194-2012
	Method of Testing for Rating of Multi-Purpose Heat Pumps for Residential Space Conditioning and Water Heating	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 206-2024
	Performance Standard for Split-System and Single-Package Central Air Conditioners and Heat Pumps	CSA	CAN/CSA-C656-14
	Installation of Air-Source Heat Pumps and Air Conditioners	CSA	CAN/CSA-C273.5-11
	Performance of Direct-Expansion (DX) Ground-Source Heat Pumps	CSA	C748-13
	Water-Source Heat Pumps—Testing and Rating for Performance, Part 1: Water-to-Air and Brine-to-Air Heat Pumps	CSA	CAN/CSA-C13256-1-01 (R2011)
	Part 2: Water-to-Water and Brine-to-Water Heat Pumps	CSA	CAN/CSA-C13256-2-01 (R2010)
	Heating and Cooling Equipment (2011)	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 1995/C22.2 No. 236-11
Gas-Fired	Gas-Fired, Heat Activated Air Conditioning and Heat Pump Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.40.1-1996/CGA 2.91-M96 (R2012)
	Gas-Fired, Work Activated Air Conditioning and Heat Pump Appliances (Internal Combustion)	CSA	ANSI Z21.40.2-1996/CGA 2.92-M96 (R2002)
	Performance Testing and Rating of Gas-Fired Air Conditioning and Heat Pump Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.40.4-1996/CGA 2.94-M96 (R2002)
Heat Recovery	Gas Turbine Heat Recovery Steam Generators	ASME	ANSI/ASME PTC 4.4-2008
	Water Heaters, Hot Water Supply Boilers, and Heat Recovery Equipment	NSF	ANSI/NSF 5-2012
High-Performance Buildings	Sustainable, High Performance Operations and Maintenance	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 32-2012
	Standard for the Design of High-Performance, Green Buildings Except Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE/ USGBC	ANSI/ASHRAE/USGBC/IES 189.1-2023
	International Green Construction Code™ (2012)	ICC	IGCC
Humidifiers	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Residential Equipment Selection	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	Comfort, Air Quality, and Efficiency by Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual RS-1997
	Bioaerosols: Assessment and Control (1999)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Humidifiers	AHAM	ANSI/AHAM HU-1-2006 (R2011)
	Central System Humidifiers for Residential Applications	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 610-2014
	Self-Contained Humidifiers for Residential Applications	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 620-2014
	Commercial and Industrial Humidifiers	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 640-2005
	Method of Test for Residential Central-System Humidifiers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 164.1-2012
	Humidifiers	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 998-2011/C22.2 No. 104-11
HVAC Load Calculations	Residential Load Calculations	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 2 Manual J-2016
	Commercial Load Calculations	ACCA	ACCA Manual N-2012
	Peak Cooling and Heating Load Calculations in Buildings Except Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE/ ACCA	ANSI/ASHRAE/ACCA 183-2024
Ice Makers	Quality Maintenance of Commercial Refrigeration Systems	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 14 QMref-2015
	Performance Rating of Automatic Commercial Ice Makers	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 811-2012
	Ice Storage Bins	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 821-2012
	Methods of Testing Automatic Ice Makers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 29-2015
	Refrigeration Equipment	CSA	C22.2 No. 120-13
	Energy Performance of Automatic Icemakers and Ice Storage Bins	CSA	CAN/CSA-C742-08 (R2014)
	Automatic Ice Making Equipment	NSF	ANSI/NSF 12-2012
	Ice Makers	UL	ANSI/UL 563-2009
Incinerators	Incinerators and Waste and Linen Handling Systems and Equipment	NFPA	NFPA 82-2014
	Residential Incinerators	UL	UL 791-2006
Indoor Air Quality	Good HVAC Practices for Residential and Commercial Buildings (2003)	ACCA	ACCA
	Comfort, Air Quality, and Efficiency by Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual RS-1997
	Bioaerosols: Assessment and Control (1999)	ACGIH	ACGIH

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Interactions Affecting the Achievement of Acceptable Indoor Environments	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 10-2016
	Ventilation for Acceptable Indoor Air Quality	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 62.1-2022
	Ventilation and Acceptable Indoor Air Quality in Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 62.2-2022
	Test Method for Determination of Volatile Organic Chemicals in Atmospheres (Canister Sampling Methodology)	ASTM	ASTM D5466-01 (2007)
	Guide for Using Probability Sampling Methods in Studies of Indoor Air Quality in Buildings	ASTM	ASTM D5791-95 (2012)e1
	Guide for Using Indoor Carbon Dioxide Concentrations to Evaluate Indoor Air Quality and Ventilation	ASTM	ASTM D6245-12
	Guide for Placement and Use of Diffusion Controlled Passive Monitors for Gaseous Pollutants in Indoor Air	ASTM	ASTM D6306-10
	Test Method for Determination of Metals and Metalloids Airborne Particulate Matter by Inductively Coupled Plasma Atomic Emissions Spectrometry (ICP-AES)	ASTM	ASTM D7035-10
	Test Method for Metal Removal Fluid Aerosol in Workplace Atmospheres	ASTM	ASTM D7049-04 (2010)
	Practice for Emission Cells for the Determination of Volatile Organic Emissions from Materials/Products	ASTM	ASTM D7143-11
	Practice for Collection of Surface Dust by Micro-Vacuum Sampling for Subsequent Metals Determination	ASTM	ASTM D7144-05a (2011)
	Test Method for Determination of Beryllium in the Workplace Using Field-Based Extraction and Optical Fluorescence Detection	ASTM	ASTM D7202-14e1
	Practice for Referencing Suprathreshold Odor Intensity	ASTM	ASTM E544-10
	Guide for Specifying and Evaluating Performance of a Single Family Attached and Detached Dwelling—Indoor Air Quality	ASTM	ASTM E2267-04 (2013)
	Classification for Serviceability of an Office Facility for Thermal Environment and Indoor Air Conditions	ASTM	ASTM E2320-04 (2012)
	Practice for Continuous Sizing and Counting of Airborne Particles in Dust-Controlled Areas and Clean Rooms Using Instruments Capable of Detecting Single Sub-Micrometre and Larger Particles	ASTM	ASTM F50-12
	Ambient Air—Determination of Mass Concentration of Nitrogen Dioxide—Modified Griess-Saltzman Method	ISO	ISO 6768:1998
	Air Quality—Exchange of Data—Part 1: General Data Format	ISO	ISO 7168-1:1999
	Part 2: Condensed Data Format	ISO	ISO 7168-2:1999
	Environmental Tobacco Smoke—Estimation of Its Contribution to Respirable Suspended Particles—Determination of Particulate Matter by Ultraviolet Absorptance and by Fluorescence	ISO	ISO 15593:2001
	Indoor Air—Part 3: Determination of Formaldehyde and Other Carbonyl Compounds in Indoor Air and Test Chamber Air—Active Sampling Method	ISO	ISO 16000-3:2011
	Workplace Air Quality—Sampling and Analysis of Volatile Organic Compounds by Solvent Desorption/Gas Chromatography—Part 1: Pumped Sampling Method	ISO	ISO 16200-1:2001
	Part 2: Diffusive Sampling Method	ISO	ISO 16200-2:2000
	Workplace Air Quality—Determination of Total Organic Isocyanate Groups in Air Using 1-(2-Methoxyphenyl) Piperazine and Liquid Chromatography	ISO	ISO 16702:2007
	Installation of Carbon Monoxide (CO) Detection and Warning Equipment	NFPA	NFPA 720-2015
	Indoor Air Quality—A Systems Approach, 3rd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 1998
	IAQ Guidelines for Occupied Buildings Under Construction, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	ANSI/SMACNA 008-2007
	Single and Multiple Station Carbon Monoxide Alarms	UL	ANSI/UL 2034-2008
Aircraft	Air Quality Within Commercial Aircraft	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 28-2016
	Air Quality Within Commercial Aircraft	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 161-2023
	Guide for Selecting Instruments and Methods for Measuring Air Quality in Aircraft Cabins	ASTM	ASTM D6399-10
	Guide for Deriving Acceptable Levels of Airborne Chemical Contaminants in Aircraft Cabins Based on Health and Comfort Considerations	ASTM	ASTM D7034-11
Modeling	Guideline for Documenting Indoor Airflow and Contaminant Transport Modeling	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 33-2013
Insulation	Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 12 QH-2014
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ACCA 2014
	Guidelines for Use of Thermal Insulation in Agricultural Buildings	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE S401.2-1993 (R2012)
	Terminology Relating to Thermal Insulating Materials	ASTM	ASTM C168-13
	Test Method for Steady-State Heat Flux Measurements and Thermal Transmission Properties by Means of the Guarded-Hot-Plate Apparatus	ASTM	ASTM C177-13
	Test Method for Steady-State Heat Transfer Properties of Pipe Insulations	ASTM	ASTM C335/C335M-10e1
	Practice for Fabrication of Thermal Insulating Fitting Covers for NPS Piping and Vessel Lagging	ASTM	ASTM C450-08 (2014)
	Test Method for Steady-State Thermal Transmission Properties by Means of the Heat Flow Meter Apparatus	ASTM	ASTM C518-10
	Specification for Preformed Flexible Elastometric Cellular Thermal Insulation in Sheet and Tubular Form	ASTM	ASTM C534/C534M-14

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Specification for Cellular Glass Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C552-14
	Specification for Rigid, Cellular Polystyrene Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C578-14a
	Practice for Inner and Outer Diameters of Thermal Insulation for Nominal Sizes of Pipe and Tubing	ASTM	ASTM C585-10
	Specification for Unfaced Preformed Rigid Cellular Polyisocyanurate Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C591-13
	Practice for Estimate of the Heat Gain or Loss and the Surface Temperatures of Insulated Flat, Cylindrical, and Spherical Systems by Use of Computer Programs	ASTM	ASTM C680-14
	Specification for Adhesives for Duct Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C916-14
	Classification of Potential Health and Safety Concerns Associated with Thermal Insulation Materials and Accessories	ASTM	ASTM C930-12
	Practice for Thermographic Inspection of Insulation Installations in Envelope Cavities of Frame Buildings	ASTM	ASTM C1060-11a
	Specification for Fibrous Glass Duct Lining Insulation (Thermal and Sound Absorbing Material)	ASTM	ASTM C1071-12
	Specification for Faced or Unfaced Rigid Cellular Phenolic Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C1126-14
	Test Method for Thermal Performance of Building Materials and Envelope Assemblies by Means of a Hot Box Apparatus	ASTM	ASTM C1363-11
	Specification for Perpendicularly Oriented Mineral Fiber Roll and Sheet Thermal Insulation for Pipes and Tanks	ASTM	ASTM C1393-14
	Guide for Measuring and Estimating Quantities of Insulated Piping and Components	ASTM	ASTM C1409-12
	Specification for Cellular Melamine Thermal and Sound-Absorbing Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C1410-14
	Guide for Selecting Jacketing Materials for Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C1423-14
	Specification for Preformed Flexible Cellular Polyolefin Thermal Insulation in Sheet and Tubular Form	ASTM	ASTM C1427-13
	Specification for Polyimide Flexible Cellular Thermal and Sound Absorbing Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C1482-12
	Specification for Cellulosic Fiber Stabilized Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C1497-12
	Test Method for Characterizing the Effect of Exposure to Environmental Cycling on Thermal Performance of Insulation Products	ASTM	ASTM C1512-10
	Specification for Flexible Polymeric Foam Sheet Insulation Used as a Thermal and Sound Absorbing Liner for Duct Systems	ASTM	ASTM C1534-14
	Standard Guide for Development of Standard Data Records for Computerization of Thermal Transmission Test Data for Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C1558-12
	Guide for Determining Blown Density of Pneumatically Applied Loose Fill Mineral Fiber Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C1574-04 (2013)
	Test Method for Determining the Moisture Content of Organic and Inorganic Insulation Materials by Weight	ASTM	ASTM C1616-07 (2012)
	Classification for Rating Sound Insulation	ASTM	ASTM E413-10
	Test Method for Determining the Drainage Efficiency of Exterior Insulation and Finish Systems (EIFS) Clad Wall Assemblies	ASTM	ASTM E2273-03 (2011)
	Practice for Use of Test Methods E96/E96M for Determining the Water Vapor Transmission (WVT) of Exterior Insulation and Finish Systems	ASTM	ASTM E2321-03 (2011)
	Thermal Insulation—Vocabulary	ISO	ISO 9229:2007
	National Commercial and Industrial Insulation Standards, 7th ed.	MICA	MICA
	Accepted Industry Practices for Sheet Metal Lagging, 1st ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2002
Legionellosis	Minimizing the Risk of Legionellosis Associated with Building Water Systems	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 12-2000
	Legionellosis: Risk Management for Building Water Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 188-2021
Louvers	Laboratory Methods of Testing Dampers for Rating	AMCA	AMCA 500-D-12
	Laboratory Methods of Testing Louvers for Rating	AMCA	AMCA 500-L-12
Lubricants	Methods of Testing the Floc Point of Refrigeration Grade Oils	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 86-2013
	Refrigeration Oil Description	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 99-2006
	Test Method for Pour Point of Petroleum Products	ASTM	ASTM D97-12
	Classification of Industrial Fluid Lubricants by Viscosity System	ASTM	ASTM D2422-97 (2013)
	Test Method for Relative Molecular Weight (Relative Molecular Mass) of Hydrocarbons by Thermoelectric Measurement of Vapor Pressure	ASTM	ASTM D2503-92 (2012)
	Test Method for Determination of Moderately High Temperature Piston Deposits by Thermo-Oxidation Engine Oil Simulation Test—TEOST MHT	ASTM	ASTM D7097-09
	Petroleum Products—Corrosiveness to Copper—Copper Strip Test	ISO	ISO 2160:1998
Measurement	Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice, 29th ed. (2016)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Engineering Analysis of Experimental Data	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 2-2010 (RA14)
	Instrumentation for Monitoring Central Chilled Water Plant Efficiency	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 22-2012
	Standard Method for Measuring the Proportion of Lubricant in Liquid Refrigerant	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 41.4-2015
	Standard Method for Measurement of Moist Air Properties	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 41.6-2021

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Methods of Determining, Expressing, and Comparing Building Energy Performance and Greenhouse Gas Emissions	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 105-2014
	Method for Establishing Installation Effects on Flowmeters	ASME	ASME MFC-10M-2000 (RA11)
	Test Uncertainty	ASME	ASME PTC 19.1-2013
	Measurement of Industrial Sound	ASME	ANSI/ASME PTC 36-2004 (RA13)
	Test Methods for Water Vapor Transmission of Materials	ASTM	ASTM E96/E96M-14
	Specification and Temperature-Electromotive Force (EMF) Tables for Standardized Thermocouples	ASTM	ASTM E230/E230M-12
	Practice for Continuous Sizing and Counting of Airborne Particles in Dust-Controlled Areas and Clean Rooms Using Instruments Capable of Detecting Single Sub-Micrometre and Larger Particles	ASTM	ASTM F50-12
	Ergonomics of the Thermal Environment—Instruments for Measuring Physical Quantities	ISO	ISO 7726:1998
	Ergonomics of the Thermal Environment—Determination of Metabolic Rate	ISO	ISO 8996:2004
	Ergonomics of the Thermal Environment—Estimation of the Thermal Insulation and Water Vapour Resistance of a Clothing Ensemble	ISO	ISO 9920:2007
Energy	Measurement of Energy and Demand Savings	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 14-2014
Fluid Flow	Standard Methods for Liquid in Flow Measurement	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 41.8-2023
	Methods for Volatile-Refrigerant Mass Flow Measurements Using Calorimeters	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 41.9-2011
	Flow Measurement	ASME	ASME PTC 19.5-2004 (RA13)
	Glossary of Terms Used in the Measurement of Fluid Flow in Pipes	ASME	ASME MFC-1M-2003 (RA08)
	Measurement Uncertainty for Fluid Flow in Closed Conduits	ASME	ANSI/ASME MFC-2M-1983 (RA13)
	Measurement of Fluid Flow in Pipes Using Orifice, Nozzle, and Venturi	ASME	ASME MFC-3M-2004
	Measurement of Fluid Flow in Pipes Using Vortex Flowmeters	ASME	ASME MFC-6M-1998 (RA05)
	Fluid Flow in Closed Conduits: Connections for Pressure Signal Transmissions Between Primary and Secondary Devices	ASME	ASME MFC-8M-2001 (RA11)
	Measurement of Liquid Flow in Closed Conduits by Weighing Method	ASME	ASME MFC-9M-1988 (RA11)
	Measurement of Fluid Flow Using Small Bore Precision Orifice Meters	ASME	ASME MFC-14M-2003 (RA08)
	Measurement of Fluid Flow in Closed Conduits by Means of Electromagnetic Flowmeters	ASME	ASME MFC-16-2014
	Measurement of Fluid Flow Using Variable Area Meters	ASME	ASME MFC-18M-2001 (RA11)
	Test Method for Determining the Moisture Content of Inorganic Insulation Materials by Weight	ASTM	ASTM C1616-07 (2012)
	Test Method for Indicating Wear Characteristics of Petroleum Hydraulic Fluids in a High Pressure Constant Volume Vane Pump	ASTM	ASTM D6973-14
	Test Method for Dynamic Viscosity and Density of Liquids by Stabinger Viscometer (and the Calculation of Kinematic Viscosity)	ASTM	ASTM D7042-14
	Test Method for Indicating Wear Characteristics of Non-Petroleum and Petroleum Hydraulic Fluids in a Constant Volume Vane Pump	ASTM	ASTM D7043-12
	Practice for Calculating Viscosity of a Blend of Petroleum Products	ASTM	ASTM D7152-11
	Test Method for Same-Different Test	ASTM	ASTM E2139-05 (2011)
	Practice for Field Use of Pyranometers, Pyrheliometers, and UV Radiometers	ASTM	ASTM G183-15
Gas Flow	Standard Methods for Laboratory Airflow Measurement	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 41.2-2022
	Method of Test for Measurement of Flow of Gas	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 41.7-2021
	Measurement of Gas Flow by Turbine Meters	ASME	ANSI/ASME MFC-4M-1986 (RA08)
	Measurement of Gas Flow by Means of Critical Flow Venturi Nozzles	ASME	ANSI/ASME MFC-7M-1987 (RA14)
Pressure	Standard Method for Pressure Measurement	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 41.3-2022
	Pressure Gauges and Gauge Attachments	ASME	ASME B40.100-2013
	Pressure Measurement	ASME	ANSI/ASME PTC 19.2-2010
Temperature	Standard Method for Temperature Measurement	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 41.1-2020
	Thermometers, Direct Reading and Remote Reading	ASME	ASME B40.200-2008 (RA13)
	Temperature Measurement	ASME	ASME PTC 19.3-1974 (RA04)
	Total Temperature Measuring Instruments (Turbine Powered Subsonic Aircraft)	SAE	SAE AS793A-2001 (R2008)
Thermal	Method of Testing Thermal Energy Meters for Liquid Streams in HVAC Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 125-2020
	Test Method for Steady-State Heat Flux Measurements and Thermal Transmission Properties by Means of the Guarded-Hot-Plate Apparatus	ASTM	ASTM C177-13
	Test Method for Steady-State Heat Flux Measurements Thermal Transmission Properties by Means of the Heat Flow Meter Apparatus	ASTM	ASTM C518-10
	Practice for In-Situ Measurement of Heat Flux and Temperature on Building Envelope Components	ASTM	ASTM C1046-95 (2013)
	Practice for Determining Thermal Resistance of Building Envelope Components from In-Situ Data	ASTM	ASTM C1155-95 (2013)
	Test Method for Thermal Performance of Building Materials and Envelope Assemblies by Means of a Hot Box Apparatus	ASTM	ASTM C1363-11

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
Mobile Homes and Recreational Vehicles	Residential Load Calculation, 8th ed.	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA Manual J-2016
	Recreational Vehicle Cooking Gas Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.57-2010
	Oil-Fired Warm Air Heating Appliances for Mobile Housing and Recreational Vehicles	CSA	B140.10-06 (R2011)
	Manufactured Homes	CSA	CAN/CSA-Z240 MH Series-09 (R2014)
	Recreational Vehicles	CSA	CAN/CSA-Z240 RV Series-08 (R2013)
	Gas Supply Connectors for Manufactured Homes	IAPMO	IAPMO TS 9-2003
	Fuel Supply: Manufactured/Mobile Home Parks & Recreational Vehicle Parks	IAPMO	Chapter 13, Part II
	Manufactured Housing Construction and Safety Standards	ICC/ANSI	HUD 24 CFR Part 3280 (2008)
	Manufactured Housing	NFPA	NFPA 501-2013
	Recreational Vehicles	NFPA	NFPA 1192-2015
	Plumbing System Components for Recreational Vehicles	NSF	ANSI/NSF 24-2010
	Low Voltage Lighting Fixtures for Use in Recreational Vehicles	UL	ANSI/UL 234-2005
	Liquid Fuel-Burning Heating Appliances for Manufactured Homes and Recreational Vehicles	UL	ANSI/UL 307A-2009
	Gas-Burning Heating Appliances for Manufactured Homes and Recreational Vehicles	UL	UL 307B-2006
Motors and Generators	Installation and Maintenance of Farm Standby Electric Power	ASABE	ANSI/ASABE EP364.3-2006
	Nuclear Power Plant Air-Cleaning Units and Components	ASME	ASME N509-2002 (RA08)
	Testing of Nuclear Air Treatment Systems	ASME	ASME N510-2007
	Fired Steam Generators	ASME	ASME PTC 4-2013
	Gas Turbine Heat Recovery Steam Generators	ASME	ASME PTC 4.4-2008 (RA13)
	Test Methods for Film-Insulated Magnet Wire	ASTM	ASTM D1676-03 (2011)
	Test Method for Evaluation of Engine Oils in a High Speed, Single-Cylinder Diesel Engine—Caterpillar 1R Test Procedure	ASTM	ASTM D6923-14
	Test Method for Evaluation of Diesel Engine Oils in the T-11 Exhaust Gas Recirculation Diesel Engine	ASTM	ASTM D7156-13
	Test Methods, Marking Requirements, and Energy Efficiency Levels for Three-Phase Induction Motors	CSA	CSA C390-10
	Motors and Generators	CSA	C22.2 No. 100-14
	Emergency Electrical Power Supply for Buildings	CSA	CSA C282-09
	Energy Efficiency Test Methods for Small Motors	CSA	CAN/CSA C747-09 (R2014)
	Standard Test Procedure for Polyphase Induction Motors and Generators	IEEE	IEEE 112-1996
	Motors and Generators	NEMA	NEMA MG 1-2014
	Energy Management Guide for Selection and Use of Fixed Frequency Medium AC Squirrel-Cage Polyphase Industrial Motors	NEMA	NEMA MG 10-2013
	Energy Management Guide for Selection and Use of Single-Phase Motors	NEMA	NEMA MG 11-1977 (R2012)
	Magnet Wire	NEMA	ANSI/NEMA MW 1000-2014
	Motion/Position Control Motors, Controls, and Feedback Devices	NEMA	NEMA ICS 16-2001
	Rotating Electrical Machines—General Requirements	UL	UL 1004-1-2012
	Electric Motors and Generators for Use in Hazardous (Classified) Locations	UL	ANSI/UL 674-2011
	Overheating Protection for Motors	UL	ANSI/UL 2111-1997
Operation and Maintenance	Maintenance of Residential HVAC Systems	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 4 QM-2013
	Preparation of Operating and Maintenance Documentation for Building Systems	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 4-2008 (RA13)
	Sustainable, High Performance Operations and Maintenance	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 32-2012
	Inspection and Maintenance of Commercial-Building HVAC Systems	ASHRAE/ ACCA	ANSI/ASHRAE/ACCA 180-2012
	International Property Maintenance Code® (2015)	ICC	IPMC
Panel Heating and Cooling	Method of Testing for Rating Ceiling Panels for Sensible Heating and Cooling	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 138-2021
Pipe, Tubing, and Fittings	Scheme for the Identification of Piping Systems	ASME	ASME A13.1-2007 (RA13)
	Pipe Threads, General Purpose (Inch)	ASME	ANSI/ASME B1.20.1-2013
	Wrought Copper and Copper Alloy Braze-Joint Pressure Fittings	ASME	ASME B16.50-2013
	Power Piping	ASME	ASME B31.1-2014
	Process Piping	ASME	ASME B31.3-2014
	Refrigeration Piping and Heat Transfer Components	ASME	ASME B31.5-2013
	Building Services Piping	ASME	ASME B31.9-2014
	Practice for Obtaining Hydrostatic or Pressure Design Basis for "Fiberglass" (Glass-Fiber-Reinforced Thermosetting-Resin) Pipe and Fittings	ASTM	ASTM D2992-12
	Specification for Welding of Austenitic Stainless Steel Tube and Piping Systems in Sanitary Applications	AWS	AWS D18.1:2009
	Standards of the Expansion Joint Manufacturers Association, 9th ed.	EJMA	EJMA
	Pipe Hangers and Supports—Materials, Design and Manufacture	MSS	ANSI/MSS SP-58-2009
	Pipe Hangers and Supports—Selection and Application	MSS	ANSI/MSS SP-69-2003

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	General Welding Guidelines (2009)	NCPWB	NCPWB
	National Fuel Gas Code	AGA/NFPA	ANSI Z223.1/NFPA 54-2015
	Refrigeration Tube Fittings—General Specifications	SAE	SAE J513-1999
	Seismic Restraint Manual—Guidelines for Mechanical Systems, 3rd ed.	SMACNA	ANSI/SMACNA 001-2008
	Tube Fittings for Flammable and Combustible Fluids, Refrigeration Service, and Marine Use	UL	ANSI/UL 109-1997
Plastic	Specification for Acrylonitrile-Butadiene-Styrene (ABS) Plastic Pipe, Schedules 40 and 80	ASTM	ASTM D1527-99 (2005)
	Specification for Poly (Vinyl Chloride) (PVC) Plastic Pipe, Schedules 40, 80, and 120	ASTM	ASTM D1785-12
	Test Method for Obtaining Hydrostatic Design Basis for Thermoplastic Pipe Materials or Pressure Design Basis for Thermoplastic Pipe Products	ASTM	ASTM D2837-13e1
	Specification for Perfluoroalkoxy (PFA)-Fluoropolymer Tubing	ASTM	ASTM D6867-03 (2014)
	Specification for Polyethylene Stay in Place Form System for End Walls for Drainage Pipe	ASTM	ASTM D7082-04 (2010)
	Specification for Chlorinated Poly (Vinyl Chloride) (CPVC) Plastic Pipe, Schedules 40 and 80	ASTM	ASTM F441/F441M-13e1
	Specification for Crosslinked Polyethylene/Aluminum/Crosslinked Polyethylene Tubing OD Controlled SDR9	ASTM	ASTM F2262-09
	Test Method for Evaluating the Oxidative Resistance of Polyethylene (PE) Pipe to Chlorinated Water	ASTM	ASTM F2263-14
	Specification for 12 to 60 in. [300 to 1500 mm] Annular Corrugated Profile-Wall Polyethylene (PE) Pipe and Fittings for Gravity-Flow Storm Sewer and Subsurface Drainage Applications	ASTM	ASTM F2306/F2306M-14
	Test Method for Determining Chemical Compatibility of Substances in Contact with Thermoplastic Pipe and Fittings Materials	ASTM	ASTM F2331-11
	Test Method for Determining Thermoplastic Pipe Wall Stiffness	ASTM	ASTM F2433-05 (2013)
	Specification for Steel Reinforced Polyethylene (PE) Corrugated Pipe	ASTM	ASTM F2435-12
	Electrical Polyvinyl Chloride (PVC) Tubing and Conduit	NEMA	NEMA TC 2-2013
	PVC Plastic Utilities Duct for Underground Installation	NEMA	NEMA TC 6 and 8-2013
	Smooth Wall Coilable Polyethylene Electrical Plastic Duct	NEMA	NEMA TC 7-2013
	Fittings for PVC Plastic Utilities Duct for Underground Installation	NEMA	NEMA TC 9-2004 (R2012)
	Electrical Nonmetallic Tubing (ENT)	NEMA	NEMA TC 13-2005
	Plastics Piping System Components and Related Materials	NSF	ANSI/NSF 14-2014
	Rubber Gasketed Fittings	UL	ANSI/UL 213-2008
Metal	Welded and Seamless Wrought Steel Pipe	ASME	ASME B36.10M-2004 (RA10)
	Stainless Steel Pipe	ASME	ASME B36.19M-2004 (RA10)
	Specification for Pipe, Steel, Black and Hot-Dipped, Zinc-Coated, Welded and Seamless	ASTM	ASTM A53/53M-12
	Specification for Seamless Carbon Steel Pipe for High-Temperature Service	ASTM	ASTM A106/A106M-14
	Specification for Steel Line Pipe, Black, Furnace-Butt-Welded	ASTM	ASTM A1037/A1037M-05 (2012)
	Specification for Composite Corrugated Steel Pipe for Sewers and Drains	ASTM	ASTM A1042/A1042M-04 (2009)
	Specification for Seamless Copper Pipe, Standard Sizes	ASTM	ASTM B42-10
	Specification for Seamless Copper Tube	ASTM	ASTM B75/B75M-11
	Specification for Seamless Copper Water Tube	ASTM	ASTM B88-14
	Specification for Seamless Copper Tube for Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Field Service	ASTM	ASTM B280-13
	Specification for Hand-Drawn Copper Capillary Tube for Restrictor Applications	ASTM	ASTM B360-09
	Specification for Welded Copper Tube for Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Service	ASTM	ASTM B640-12a
	Specification for Copper-Beryllium Seamless Tube UNS Nos. C17500 and C17510	ASTM	ASTM B937-04 (2010)
	Test Method for Rapid Determination of Corrosiveness to Copper from Petroleum Products Using a Disposable Copper Foil Strip	ASTM	ASTM D7095-04 (2014)
	Thickness Design of Ductile-Iron Pipe	AWWA	ANSI/AWWA C150/A21.50-14
	Fittings, Cast Metal Boxes, and Conduit Bodies for Conduit and Cable Assemblies	NEMA	NEMA FB 1-2012
	Polyvinyl-Chloride (PVC) Externally Coated Galvanized Rigid Steel Conduit and Intermediate Metal Conduit	NEMA	NEMA RN 1-2005 (R2013)
Plumbing	Backwater Valves	ASME	ASME A112.14.1-2003 (RA12)
	Plumbing Supply Fittings	ASME	ASME A112.18.1-2012
	Plumbing Waste Fittings	ASME	ASME A112.18.2-2011
	Performance Requirements for Backflow Protection Devices and Systems in Plumbing Fixture Fittings	ASME	ASME A112.18.3-2002 (RA12)
	Uniform Plumbing Code (2012) (with IAPMO Installation Standards)	IAPMO	IAPMO
	International Plumbing Code® (2015)	ICC	IPC
	International Private Sewage Disposal Code® (2015)	ICC	IPSDC
	2012 National Standard Plumbing Code (NSPC)	PHCC	NSPC 2012
	2012 National Standard Plumbing Code—Illustrated	PHCC	PHCC 2012

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Standard Plumbing Code (1997)	SBCCI	SPC
Pumps	Balancing and Testing Air and Hydronic Systems	ACCA	ACCA Manual B-2009
	Centrifugal Pumps	ASME	ASME PTC 8.2-1990
	Specification for Horizontal End Suction Centrifugal Pumps for Chemical Process	ASME	ASME B73.1-2012
	Specification for Vertical-in-Line Centrifugal Pumps for Chemical Process	ASME	ASME B73.2-2003 (RA08)
	Specification for Sealless Horizontal End Suction Metallic Centrifugal Pumps for Chemical Process	ASME	ASME B73.3-2003 (RA08)
	Specification for Thermoplastic and Thermoset Polymer Material Horizontal End Suction Centrifugal Pumps for Chemical Process	ASME	ASME B73.5M-1995 (RA07)
	Liquid Pumps	CSA	CAN/CSA-C22.2 No. 108-14
	Energy Efficiency Test Methods for Small Pumps	CSA	CAN/CSA C820-02 (R2012)
	Performance Standard for Liquid Ring Vacuum Pumps, 4th ed. (2011)	HEI	HEI 2854
	Rotodynamic (Centrifugal) Pumps for Nomenclature and Definitions	HI	ANSI/HI 1.1-1.2-2014
	Rotodynamic (Centrifugal) Pumps for Design and Application	HI	ANSI/HI 1.3-2013
	Rotodynamic (Centrifugal) Pumps for Manuals Describing Installation, Operation and Maintenance	HI	ANSI/HI 1.4-2014
	Rotodynamic (Vertical) Nomenclature	HI	ANSI/HI 2.1-2.2-2014
	Rotodynamic (Vertical) Application	HI	ANSI/HI 2.3-2013
	Rotodynamic (Vertical) Operations	HI	ANSI/HI 2.4-2014
	Rotary Pumps for Nomenclature, Definitions, Application, and Operation	HI	ANSI/HI 3.1-3.5-2008
	Sealless, Magnetically Driven Rotary Pumps for Nomenclature, Definitions, Application, Operation, and Test	HI	ANSI/HI 4.1-4.6-2010
	Sealless Rotodynamic Pumps for Nomenclature, Definitions, Application, Operation, and Test	HI	ANSI/HI 5.1-5.6-2010
	Reciprocating Pumps for Nomenclature, Definitions, Application, and Operation	HI	ANSI/HI 6.1-6.5-2000
	Direct Acting (Steam) Pumps for Nomenclature, Definitions, Application, and Operation	HI	ANSI/HI 8.1-8.5-2000
	Pumps—General Guidelines for Types, Definitions, Application, Sound Measurement and Decontamination	HI	ANSI/HI 9.1-9.5-2000
	Rotodynamic Pumps for Assessment of Allowable Nozzle Loads	HI	ANSI/HI 9.6.2-2011
	Centrifugal and Vertical Pumps for Allowable Operating Region	HI	ANSI/HI 9.6.3-2012
	Rotodynamic Pumps for Vibration Measurements and Allowable Values	HI	ANSI/HI 9.6.4-2009
	Rotodynamic (Centrifugal and Vertical) Pumps Guideline for Condition Monitoring	HI	ANSI/HI 9.6.5-2009
	Intake Design for Rotodynamic Pumps	HI	ANSI/HI 9.8-2012
	Engineering Data Book, 2nd ed.	HI	HI (1990)
	Equipment for Swimming Pools, Spas, Hot Tubs and Other Recreational Water Facilities	NSF	ANSI/NSF 50-2013
	Pumps for Oil-Burning Appliances	UL	UL 343-2008
	Motor-Operated Water Pumps	UL	ANSI/UL 778-2010
	Swimming Pool Pumps, Filters, and Chlorinators	UL	ANSI/UL 1081-2008
Radiators	Balancing and Testing Air and Hydronic Systems	ACCA	ACCA Manual B-2009
	Testing and Rating Standard for Baseboard Radiation, 8th ed. (2005)	HYDI	IBR
	Testing and Rating Standard for Finned Tube (Commercial) Radiation, 6th ed. (2005)	HYDI	IBR
Receivers	Refrigerant Liquid Receivers	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 495-2005
	Refrigerant-Containing Components and Accessories, Nonelectrical	UL	ANSI/UL 207-2009
Refrigerants	Threshold Limit Values for Chemical Substances (updated annually)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Specifications for Refrigerants	AHRI	AHRI 700-2014
	Refrigerant Recovery/Recycling Equipment	AHRI	AHRI 740-1998
	Refrigerant Information Recommended for Product Development and Standards	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 6-2015
	Method of Testing Flow Capacity of Refrigerant Capillary Tubes	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 28-1996 (RA20)
	Designation and Safety Classification of Refrigerants	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 34-2022
	Sealed Glass Tube Method to Test the Chemical Stability of Materials for Use Within Refrigerant Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 97-2007
	Refrigeration Oil Description	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 99-2006
	Reducing the Release of Halogenated Refrigerants from Refrigerating and Air-Conditioning Equipment and Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 147-2013
	Methods of Testing Capacity for Refrigerant Pressure Regulators	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 158.2-2011
	Method of Test to Determine the Performance of Halocarbon Refrigerant Leak Detectors	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 173-2012
	Test Method for Acid Number of Petroleum Products by Potentiometric Titration	ASTM	ASTM D664-11a
	Test Method for Concentration Limits of Flammability of Chemical (Vapors and Gases)	ASTM	ASTM E681-09
	Refrigerant-Containing Components for Use in Electrical Equipment	CSA	C22.2 No. 140.3-09 (R2014)
	Refrigerants—Designation System	ISO	ISO 817:2014
	Procedure Retrofitting CFC-12 (R-12) Mobile Air-Conditioning Systems to HFC-134a (R-134a)	SAE	SAE J1661-2011

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Recommended Service Procedure for the Containment of CFC-12 (R-12)	SAE	SAE J1989-2011
	Standard of Purity for Recycled R-134a (HFC-134a) and R-1234yf (HFO-1234yf) for Use in Mobile Air-Conditioning Systems	SAE	SAE J2099-2012
	HFC-134a (R-134a) Service Hose Fittings for Automotive Air-Conditioning Service Equipment	SAE	SAE J2197-2011
	CFC-12 (R-12) Refrigerant Recovery Equipment for Mobile Automotive Air-Conditioning Systems	SAE	SAE J2209-2011
	Recommended Service Procedure for the Containment of HFC-134a	SAE	SAE J2211-2011
	Refrigerant-Containing Components and Accessories, Nonelectrical	UL	ANSI/UL 207-2009
	Refrigerant Recovery/Recycling Equipment	UL	ANSI/UL 1963-2011
	Refrigerants	UL	ANSI/UL 2182-2006
Refrigeration	Quality Maintenance of Commercial Refrigeration Systems	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 14 QMref-2015
	Safety Standard for Refrigeration Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 15-2022
	Mechanical Refrigeration Code	CSA	B52-13
	Refrigeration Equipment	CSA	CAN/CSA-C22.2 No. 120-13
	Equipment, Design and Installation of Ammonia Mechanical Refrigerating Systems	IIAR	ANSI/IIAR 2-2008
	Refrigerated Medical Equipment	UL	ANSI/UL 416-1993
Refrigeration Systems	Ejectors	ASME	ASME PTC 24-1976 (RA82)
	Safety Standard for Refrigeration Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 15-2022
	Designation and Safety Classification of Refrigerants	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 34-2022
	Reducing the Release of Halogenated Refrigerants from Refrigerating and Air-Conditioning Equipment and Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 147-2013
	Testing of Refrigerating Systems	ISO	ISO 916-1968
	Standards for Steam Jet Vacuum Systems, 7th ed. (2012)	HEI	HEI 2866-1
Transport	Mechanical Transport Refrigeration Units	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 1111-2013
	Mechanical Refrigeration and Air-Conditioning Installations Aboard Ship	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 26-2010 (RA20)
	General Requirements for Application of Vapor Cycle Refrigeration Systems for Aircraft	SAE	SAE ARP731C-2003 (R2010)
	Safety Standard for Motor Vehicle Refrigerant Vapor Compression Systems	SAE	SAE J639-2011
Refrigerators			
Commercial	Quality Maintenance of Commercial Refrigeration Systems	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 14 QMref-2015
	Method of Testing Commercial Refrigerators and Freezers	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 72-2022
	Energy Performance Standard for Commercial Refrigerated Display Cabinets and Merchandise	CSA	CAN/CSA-C657-12
	Energy Performance of Food Service Refrigerators and Freezers	CSA	C827-10
	Gas Food Service Equipment	CSA	ANSI Z83.11-2006/CSA 1.8A-2006 (R2011)
	Food Equipment	NSF	ANSI/NSF 2-2014
	Commercial Refrigerators and Freezers	NSF	ANSI/NSF 7-2014
	Mobile Food Carts	NSF	ANSI/NSF 59-2012
	Refrigeration Unit Coolers	UL	ANSI/UL 412-2011
	Refrigerating Units	UL	ANSI/UL 427-2011
	Commercial Refrigerators and Freezers	UL	ANSI/UL 471-2010
Household	Refrigerators, Refrigerator-Freezers and Freezers	AHAM	ANSI/AHAM HRF-1-2008
	Refrigerators Using Gas Fuel	CSA	ANSI Z21.19-2014/CSA1.4-2014
	Energy Performance and Capacity of Household Refrigerators, Refrigerator-Freezers, Freezers, and Wine Chillers	CSA	CAN/CSA C300-12
	Household Refrigerators and Freezers	UL/CSA	ANSI/UL 250-1993/C22.2 No. 63-93 (R2013)
Retrofitting			
Building	Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 12 QH-2014
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Home Evaluation and Performance Improvement	ACCA	ACCA 2015
	Technician's Guide & Workbook for Duct Diagnostics and Repair	ACCA	ACCA 2016
	Bob's House	ACCA	ACCA 2008
	Good HVAC Practices for Residential and Commercial Buildings	ACCA	ACCA 2003
	Building Systems Analysis and Retrofit Manual, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2011
Refrigerant	Procedure for Retrofitting CFC-12 (R-12) Mobile Air Conditioning Systems to HFC-134a (R-134a)	SAE	SAE J1661-2011
Roof Ventilators	Commercial Low Pressure, Low Velocity Duct System Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual Q-1990
	Power Ventilators	UL	ANSI/UL 705-2004
Safety	Guideline for Risk Management of Public Health and Safety in Buildings	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 29-2009
Seismic Restraint	Method of Test of Seismic Restraint Devices for HVAC&R Equipment	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 171-2008
	Seismic Restraint Manual—Guidelines for Mechanical Systems, 3rd ed.	SMACNA	ANSI/SMACNA 001-2008

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
Smoke Control Systems	The Commissioning Process for Smoke Management Systems	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 1.5-2012
	Laboratory Methods of Testing Fans Used to Exhaust Smoke in Smoke Management Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 149-2013
	Smoke-Control Systems Utilizing Barriers and Pressure Differences	NFPA	NFPA 92A-2009
	Smoke Management Systems in Malls, Atria, and Large Spaces	NFPA	NFPA 92B-2009
	Ceiling Dampers	UL	ANSI/UL 555C-2014
	Smoke Dampers	UL	ANSI/UL 555S-2014
Solar Equipment	Thermal Performance Testing of Solar Ambient Air Heaters	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE S423-1991 (R2012)
	Testing and Reporting Solar Cooker Performance	ASABE	ASAE S580.1-2013
	Method of Measuring Solar-Optical Properties of Materials	ASHRAE	ASHRAE 74-1988
	Methods of Testing to Determine the Thermal Performance of Solar Collectors	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 93-2010 (RA14)
	Methods of Testing to Determine the Thermal Performance of Solar Domestic Water Heating Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 95-1981 (RA87)
	Methods of Testing to Determine the Thermal Performance of Unglazed Flat-Plate Liquid-Type Solar Collectors	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 96-1980 (RA89)
	Practice for Installation and Service of Solar Space Heating Systems for One and Two Family Dwellings	ASTM	ASTM E683-91 (2013)
	Practice for Evaluating Thermal Insulation Materials for Use in Solar Collectors	ASTM	ASTM E861-13
	Practice for Installation and Service of Solar Domestic Water Heating Systems for One and Two Family Dwellings	ASTM	ASTM E1056-13
	Reference Solar Spectral Irradiance at the Ground at Different Receiving Conditions—Part 1: Direct Normal and Hemispherical Solar Irradiance for Air Mass 1.5	ISO	ISO 9845:1992
	Solar Collectors	CSA	CAN/CSA F378 Series-11
	Packaged Solar Domestic Hot Water Systems (Liquid to Liquid Heat Transfer)	CSA	CAN/CSA F379 Series-09 (R2013)
	Installation Code for Solar Domestic Hot Water Systems	CSA	CAN/CSA F383-08 (R2013)
	Solar Heating—Domestic Water Heating Systems—Part 2: Outdoor Test Methods for System Performance Characterization and Yearly Performance Prediction of Solar-Only Systems	ISO	ISO 9459-2:1995
	Solar Energy—Solar Thermal Collectors—Test Methods	ISO	ISO 9806:2013
	Solar Water Heaters—Elastomeric Materials for Absorbers, Connecting Pipes and Fittings—Method of Assessment	ISO	ISO 9808:1990
	Solar Energy—Calibration of a Pyranometer Using a Pyrheliometer	ISO	ISO 9846:1993
Solenoid Valves	Solenoid Valves for Use with Volatile Refrigerants	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 760-2014
	Methods of Testing Capacity of Refrigerant Solenoid Valves	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 158.1-2024
	Electrically Operated Valves	UL	UL 429-2013
Sound Measurement	Threshold Limit Values for Physical Agents (updated annually)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Specification for Sound Level Meters	ASA	ANSI S1.4-2014
	Specification for Octave-Band and Fractional-Octave-Band Analog and Digital Filters	ASA	ANSI S1.11-2014
	Microphones, Part 1: Specifications for Laboratory Standard Microphones	ASA	ANSI S1.15-1997/Part 1 (R2011)
	Part 2: Primary Method for Pressure Calibration of Laboratory Standard Microphones by the Reciprocity Technique	ASA	ANSI S1.15-2005/Part 2 (R2010)
	Specification for Acoustical Calibrators	ASA	ANSI S1.40-2006 (R2011)
	Measurement of Industrial Sound	ASME	ASME PTC 36-2004 (RA13)
	Test Method for Measuring Acoustical and Airflow Performance of Duct Liner Materials and Prefabricated Silencers	ASTM	ASTM E477-13
	Test Method for Determination of Decay Rates for Use in Sound Insulation Test Methods	ASTM	ASTM E2235-04 (2012)
	Procedural Standards for the Measurement of Sound and Vibration, 2nd ed. (2006)	NEBB	NEBB
	HVAC Systems Sound and Vibration Procedural Guide, 1st ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2013
Fans	Reverberant Room Method for Sound Testing of Fans	AMCA	AMCA 300-08
	Methods for Calculating Fan Sound Ratings from Laboratory Test Data	AMCA	AMCA 301-90
	Application of Sone Ratings for Non-Ducted Air Moving Devices	AMCA	AMCA 302-73 (R2008)
	Application of Sound Power Level Ratings for Fans	AMCA	AMCA 303-79 (R2008)
	Acoustics—Measurement of Airborne Noise Emitted and Structure-Borne Vibration Induced by Small Air-Moving Devices—Part 1: Airborne Noise Measurement	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.11-1-2013/ISO 10302-1:2013
	Part 2: Structure-Borne Vibration	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.11-2-2013/ISO 10302-2:2013
Other Equipment	Sound Rating of Outdoor Unitary Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 270-2008
	Application of Sound Rating Levels of Outdoor Unitary Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 275-2010
	Sound Rating and Sound Transmission Loss of Packaged Terminal Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 300-2008
	Sound Rating of Non-Ducted Indoor Air-Conditioning Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 350-2008
	Sound Rating of Large Air-Cooled Outdoor Refrigerating and Air-Conditioning Equipment	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 370-2011

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Method of Rating Sound and Vibration of Refrigerant Compressors	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 530-2011
	Method of Measuring Machinery Sound Within an Equipment Space	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 575-2008
	Statistical Methods for Determining and Verifying Stated Noise Emission Values of Machinery and Equipment	ASA	ANSI S12.3-1985 (R2011)
	Sound Level Prediction for Installed Rotating Electrical Machines	NEMA	NEMA MG 3-1974 (R2012)
Techniques	Preferred Frequencies, Frequency Levels, and Band Numbers for Acoustical Measurements	ASA	ANSI/ASA S1.6-1984 (R2011)
	Reference Quantities for Acoustical Levels	ASA	ANSI/ASA S1.8-1989 (R2011)
	Measurement of Sound Pressure Levels in Air	ASA	ANSI/ASA S1.13-2005 (R2010)
	Procedure for the Computation of Loudness of Steady Sound	ASA	ANSI/ASA S3.4-2007 (R2012)
	Criteria for Evaluating Room Noise	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.2-2008
	Methods for Determining the Insertion Loss of Outdoor Noise Barriers	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.8-1998 (R2013)
	Engineering Method for the Determination of Sound Power Levels of Noise Sources Using Sound Intensity	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.12-1992 (R2012)
	Procedures for Outdoor Measurement of Sound Pressure Level	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.18-1994 (R2009)
	Methods for Measurement of Sound Emitted by Machinery and Equipment at Workstations and Other Specified Positions	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.43-1997 (R2012)
	Methods for Calculation of Sound Emitted by Machinery and Equipment at Workstations and Other Specified Positions from Sound Power Level	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.44-1997 (R2012)
	Acoustics—Determination of Sound Power Levels and Sound Energy Levels of Noise Sources Using Sound Pressure—Precision Method for Reverberation Test Rooms	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.51-2012/ISO 3741:2012
	Acoustics—Determination of Sound Power Levels of Noise Sources Using Sound Pressure—Engineering Methods for Small, Movable Sources in Reverberant Fields—Part 1: Comparison Method for Hard-Walled Test Rooms	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.53/Part 1-2011/ISO 3743-1:2011
	Part 2: Methods for Special Reverberation Test Rooms	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.53/Part 2-1999 (R2015)/ISO 3743-2:1999 (R2015)
	Acoustics—Determination of Sound Power Levels and Sound Energy Levels of Noise Sources Using Sound Pressure—Engineering Methods for an Essentially Free Field over a Reflecting Plane	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.54-2011/ISO 3744:2011
	Acoustics—Determination of Sound Power Levels and Sound Energy Levels of Noise Sources Using Sound Pressure—Survey Method Using an Enveloping Measurement Surface over a Reflecting Plane	ASA	ANSI/ASA S12.56-2011/ISO 3746:2011
	Test Method for Impedance and Absorption of Acoustical Materials by the Impedance Tube Method	ASTM	ASTM C384-04 (2011)
	Test Method for Sound Absorption and Sound Absorption Coefficients by the Reverberation Room Method	ASTM	ASTM C423-09a
	Test Method for Measurement of Airborne Sound Attenuation Between Rooms in Buildings	ASTM	ASTM E336-14
	Test Method for Impedance and Absorption of Acoustical Materials Using a Tube, Two Microphones and a Digital Frequency Analysis System	ASTM	ASTM E1050-12
	Test Method for Evaluating Masking Sound in Open Offices Using A-Weighted and One-Third Octave Band Sound Pressure Levels	ASTM	ASTM E1573-09
	Test Method for Measurement of Sound in Residential Spaces	ASTM	ASTM E1574-98 (2014)
	Acoustics—Method for Calculating Loudness Level	ISO	ISO 532:1975
	Acoustics—Determination of Sound Power Levels of Noise Sources Using Sound Intensity; Part 1: Measurement at Discrete Points	ISO	ISO 9614-1:1993
	Part 2: Measurement by Scanning	ISO	ISO 9614-2:1996
	Procedural Standards for the Measurement of Sound and Vibration, 2nd ed. (2006)	NEBB	NEBB
Terminology	Acoustical Terminology	ASA	ANSI S1.1-1994 (R2004)
	Terminology Relating to Building and Environmental Acoustics	ASTM	ASTM C634-13
Space Heaters	Methods of Testing for Rating Combination Space-Heating and Water-Heating Appliances	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 124-2007
	Gas-Fired Room Heaters, Vol. II, Unvented Room Heaters	CSA	ANSI Z21.11.2-2013
	Vented Gas-Fired Space Heating Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.86-2008/CSA 2.32-2008 (R2014)
	Movable and Wall- or Ceiling-Hung Electric Room Heaters	UL	UL 1278-2014
	Fixed and Location-Dedicated Electric Room Heaters	UL	UL 2021-2013
Sustainability	Sustainable, High Performance Operations and Maintenance	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 32-2012
	Standard for the Design of High-Performance, Green Buildings Except Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE/ USGBC	ANSI/ASHRAE/USGBC/IES 189.1-2023
	International Green Construction Code™ (2012)	ICC	IGCC
Symbols	Graphic Symbols for Heating, Ventilating, Air-Conditioning, and Refrigerating Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 134-2005 (RA14)
	Graphical Symbols for Plumbing Fixtures for Diagrams Used in Architecture and Building Construction	ASME	ANSI/ASME Y32.4-1977 (RA04)

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Symbols for Mechanical and Acoustical Elements as Used in Schematic Diagrams	ASME	ANSI/ASME Y32.18-1972 (RA13)
	Practice for Mechanical Symbols, Shipboard Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning (HVAC)	ASTM	ASTM F856-97 (2014)
	Standard Symbols for Welding, Brazing, and Nondestructive Examination	AWS	AWS A2.4:2012
	Graphic Symbols for Electrical and Electronics Diagrams	IEEE	ANSI/CSA/IEEE 315-1975 (R1993)
	Standard for Logic Circuit Diagrams	IEEE	IEEE 991-1986 (R1994)
	American National Standard for Metric Practice	IEEE/ASTM	IEEE/ASTM-SI10-10
	Abbreviations and Acronyms for Use on Drawings and Related Documents	ASME	ASME Y14.38-2007 (RA13)
	Engineering Drawing Practices	ASME	ASME Y14.100-2013
	American National Standard for Safety Colors	NEMA	ANSI/NEMA Z535.1-2006 (R2011)
Terminals, Wiring	Electrical Quick-Connect Terminals	UL	ANSI/UL 310-2014
	Wire Connectors	UL	ANSI/UL 486A-486B-2013
	Splicing Wire Connectors	UL	ANSI/UL 486C-2013
	Equipment Wiring Terminals for Use with Aluminum and/or Copper Conductors	UL	ANSI/UL 486E-2009
Testing and Balancing	AABC National Standards for Total System Balance (2002)	AABC	AABC
	Balancing and Testing Air and Hydronic Systems	ACCA	ACCA Manual B-2009
	Industrial Process/Power Generation Fans: Site Performance Test Standard	AMCA	AMCA 803-02 (R2008)
	Guidelines for Measuring and Reporting Environmental Parameters for Plant Experiments in Growth Chambers	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE EP411.5-2012
	HVAC&R Technical Requirements for the Commissioning Process	ASHRAE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 1.1-2007
	Measurement, Testing, Adjusting, and Balancing of Building HVAC Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 111-2008
	Rotary Pump Tests	HI	ANSI/HI 3.6-2010
	Air-Operated Pump Tests	HI	ANSI/HI 10.6-2010
	Pumps—General Guidelines for Types, Definitions, Application, Sound Measurement and Decontamination	HI	HI 9.1-9.5-2000
	Rotodynamic Submersible Pump Tests	HI	ANSI/HI 11.6-2012
	Procedural Standards for Certified Testing of Cleanrooms, 3rd ed. (2009)	NEBB	NEBB
	Procedural Standards for TAB Environmental Systems, 8th ed. (2015)	NEBB	NEBB
	HVAC Systems Testing, Adjusting and Balancing, 3rd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2002
Thermal Storage	Thermal Energy Storage: A Guide for Commercial HVAC Contractors	ACCA	ACCA 2005
	Method of Testing Thermal Storage Devices with Electrical Input and Thermal Output Based on Thermal Performance	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 94.2-2010
	Measurement, Testing, Adjusting, and Balancing of Building HVAC Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 111-2008
	Method of Testing the Performance of Cool Storage Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 150-2000 (RA14)
Transformers	Minimum Efficiency Values for Liquid-Filled Distribution Transformers	CSA	CAN/CSA-C802.1-13
	Minimum Efficiency Values for Dry-Type Transformers	CSA	CAN/CSA-C802.2-12
	Maximum Losses For Power Transformers	CSA	CAN/CSA-C802.3-01 (R2012)
	Guide for Determining Energy Efficiency of Distribution Transformers	NEMA	NEMA TP-1-2002
Turbines	Steam Turbines	ASME	ASME PTC 6-2004 (RA14)
	Steam Turbines in Combined Cycle	ASME	ASME PTC 6.2-2011
	Hydraulic Turbines and Pump-Turbines	ASME	ASME PTC 18-2011
	Gas Turbines	ASME	ASME PTC 22-2014
	Wind Turbines	ASME	ASME PTC 42-1988 (RA04)
	Specification for Stainless Steel Bars for Compressor and Turbine Airfoils	ASTM	ASTM A1028-03 (2009)
	Specification for Gas Turbine Fuel Oils	ASTM	ASTM D2880-14a
	Steam Turbines for Mechanical Drive Service	NEMA	NEMA SM 23-1991 (R2002)
	Land Based Steam Turbine Generator Sets, 0 to 33 000 kW	NEMA	NEMA SM 24-1991 (R2002)
Valves	Face-to-Face and End-to-End Dimensions of Valves	ASME	ASME B16.10-2009
	Valves—Flanged, Threaded, and Welding End	ASME	ASME B16.34-2013
	Manually Operated Metallic Gas Valves for Use in Aboveground Piping Systems up to 5 psi	ASME	ASME B16.44-2012
	Pressure Relief Devices	ASME	ASME PTC 25-2014
	Methods of Testing Capacity of Refrigerant Solenoid Valves	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 158.1-2024
	Relief Valves for Hot Water Supply	CSA	ANSI Z21.22-1999/CSA 4.4-1999 (R2014)
	Control Valve Capacity Test Procedures	ISA	ANSI/ISA-S75.02.01-2008
	Metal Valves for Use in Flanged Pipe Systems—Face-to-Face and Centre-to-Face Dimensions	ISO	ISO 5752:1982
	Safety Valves for Protection Against Excessive Pressure, Part 1: Safety Valves	ISO	ISO 4126-1:2013
	Oxygen System Fill/Check Valve	SAE	SAE AS1225A-1997 (R2012)
	Flow Control Valves for Anhydrous Ammonia and LP-Gas	UL	ANSI/UL 125-2014
	Safety Relief Valves for Anhydrous Ammonia and LP-Gas	UL	ANSI/UL 132-2007

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	LP-Gas Regulators	UL	ANSI/UL 144-2012
	Electrically Operated Valves	UL	UL 429-2013
	Valves for Flammable Fluids	UL	ANSI/UL 842-2007
Gas	Manually Operated Metallic Gas Valves for Use in Gas Piping Systems up to 125 psig (Sizes NPS 1/2 through 2)	ASME	ASME B16.33-2012
	Large Metallic Valves for Gas Distribution (Manually Operated, NPS-2 1/2 to 12, 125 psig Maximum)	ASME	ANSI/ASME B16.38-2012
	Manually Operated Thermoplastic Gas Shutoffs and Valves in Gas Distribution Systems	ASME	ASME B16.40-2013
	Manually Operated Gas Valves for Appliances, Appliance Connection Valves, and Hose End Valves	CSA	ANSI Z21.15-2009/CGA 9.1-2009 (R2014)
	Automatic Valves for Gas Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.21-2012/CGA 6.5-2012
	Combination Gas Controls for Gas Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.78-2010/CGA 6.20-2010
	Convenience Gas Outlets and Optional Enclosures	CSA	ANSI Z21.90-2001/CSA 6.24-2001 (R2011)
Refrigerant	Thermostatic Refrigerant Expansion Valves	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 750-2007
	Solenoid Valves for Use with Volatile Refrigerants	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 760-2014
	Refrigerant Pressure Regulating Valves	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 770-2014
	Method of Testing Thermostatic Refrigerant Expansion Valves	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 17-2022
	Methods of Testing Capacity of Refrigerant Solenoid Valves	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 158.1-2024
Vapor Retarders	Practice for Selection of Water Vapor Retarders for Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C755-10
	Practice for Determining the Properties of Jacketing Materials for Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C921-10
	Specification for Flexible, Low Permeance Vapor Retarders for Thermal Insulation	ASTM	ASTM C1136-12
Vending Machines	Methods of Testing for Rating Vending Machines for Sealed Beverages	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 32.1-2022
	Methods of Testing for Rating Pre-Mix and Post-Mix Beverage Dispensing Equipment	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 32.2-2018 (RA22)
	Vending Machines	CSA	C22.2 No. 128-95 (R2013)
	Energy Performance of Vending Machines	CSA	CAN/CSA C804-09 (R2014)
	Vending Machines for Food and Beverages	NSF	ANSI/NSF 25-2012
	Refrigerated Vending Machines	UL	ANSI/UL 541-2011
	Vending Machines	UL	ANSI/UL 751-2012
Vent Dampers	Automatic Vent Damper Devices for Use with Gas-Fired Appliances	CSA	ANSI Z21.66-1996/CSA 6.14-M96 (R2011)
	Vent or Chimney Connector Dampers for Oil-Fired Appliances	UL	ANSI/UL 17-2008
Ventilation	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Residential Equipment Selection	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 3 Manual S-2014
	Residential Duct Systems	ACCA	ANSI/ACCA 1 Manual D-2016
	Commercial Low Pressure, Low Velocity Duct System Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual Q-1990
	Comfort, Air Quality, and Efficiency by Design	ACCA	ACCA Manual RS-1997
	Guide for Testing Ventilation Systems (1991)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Industrial Ventilation: A Manual of Recommended Practice, 29th ed. (2016)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Design of Ventilation Systems for Poultry and Livestock Shelters	ASABE	ASAE EP270.5-1986 (R2012)
	Design Values for Emergency Ventilation and Care of Livestock and Poultry	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE EP282.2-1993 (R2013)
	Heating, Ventilating and Cooling Greenhouses	ASABE	ANSI/ASAE EP406.4-2003 (R2008)
	Guidelines for Selection of Energy Efficient Agricultural Ventilation Fans	ASABE	ASAE EP566.2-2012
	Uniform Terminology for Livestock Production Facilities	ASABE	ASAE S501-1990 (R2011)
	Agricultural Ventilation Constant Speed Fan Test Standard	ASABE	ASABE S565-2005 (R2011)
	Guide for the Ventilation and Thermal Management of Batteries for Stationary Applications	ASHRAE/ IEEE	ASHRAE *Guideline* 21-2012/IEEE 1635-2012
	Ventilation for Acceptable Indoor Air Quality	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 62.1-2022
	Ventilation and Acceptable Indoor Air Quality in Low-Rise Residential Buildings	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 62.2-2022
	Method of Testing for Room Air Diffusion	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 113-2022
	Measuring Air Change Effectiveness	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 129-1997 (RA02)
	Ventilation for Commercial Cooking Operations	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 154-2016
	Ventilation of Health Care Facilities	ASHRAE/ ASHE	ANSI/ASHRAE/ASHE 170-2013
	Residential Mechanical Ventilation Systems	CSA	CAN/CSA F326-M91 (R2010)
	Parking Structures	NFPA	NFPA 88A-2015
	Installation of Air-Conditioning and Ventilating Systems	NFPA	NFPA 90A-2015
	Ventilation Control and Fire Protection of Commercial Cooking Operations	NFPA	NFPA 96-2014
	Food Equipment	NSF	ANSI/NSF 2-2014
	Biosafety Cabinetry: Design, Construction, Performance, and Field Certification	NSF	ANSI/NSF 49-2012
	Aerothermodynamic Systems Engineering and Design	SAE	SAE AIR1168/3-1989 (R2011)
	Heater, Airplane, Engine Exhaust Gas to Air Heat Exchanger Type	SAE	SAE ARP86-2011

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Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
	Test Procedure for Battery Flame Retardant Venting Systems	SAE	SAE J1495-2013
Venting	Commercial Systems Overview	ACCA	ACCA Manual CS-1993
	Draft Hoods	CSA	ANSI Z21.12-1990 (R2000)
	National Fuel Gas Code	AGA/NFPA	ANSI Z223.1/NFPA 54-2015
	Explosion Prevention Systems	NFPA	NFPA 69-2014
	Smoke and Heat Venting	NFPA	NFPA 204-2015
	Chimneys, Fireplaces, Vents and Solid Fuel-Burning Appliances	NFPA	NFPA 211-2013
	Guide for Free Standing Steel Stack Construction, 2nd ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2011
	Guyed Steel Stacks	SMACNA	SMACNA 2011
	Draft Equipment	UL	UL 378-2006
	Gas Vents	UL	ANSI/UL 441-2010
	Type L Low-Temperature Venting Systems	UL	ANSI/UL 641-2010
Vibration	Balance Quality and Vibration Levels for Fans	AMCA	ANSI/AMCA 204-05 (R2012)
	Techniques of Machinery Vibration Measurement	ASA	ANSI/ASA S2.17-1980 (R2004)
	Mechanical Vibration and Shock—Resilient Mounting Systems—Part 1: Technical Information to Be Exchanged for the Application of Isolation Systems	ISO	ISO 2017-1:2005
	Evaluation of Human Exposure to Whole-Body Vibration—Part 2: Vibration in Buildings (1 Hz to 80 Hz)	ISO	ISO 2631-2:2003
	Guidelines for the Evaluation of the Response of Occupants of Fixed Structures, Especially Buildings and Off-Shore Structures, to Low-Frequency Horizontal Motion (0.063 to 1 Hz)	ISO	ISO 6897:1984
	Procedural Standards for the Measurement of Sound and Vibration, 2nd ed. (2006)	NEBB	NEBB
	HVAC Systems Sound and Vibration Procedural Guide, 1st ed.	SMACNA	SMACNA 2013
Water Heaters	Desuperheater/Water Heaters	AHRI	ANSI/AHRI 470-2006
	Safety for Electrically Heated Livestock Waterers	ASABE	ASAE EP342.3-2010
	Methods of Testing to Determine the Thermal Performance of Solar Domestic Water Heating Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 95-1981 (RA87)
	Method of Testing for Rating Commercial Gas, Electric, and Oil Service Water Heating Equipment	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 118.1-2022
	Method of Testing for Rating Residential Water Heaters	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 118.2-2022
	Methods of Testing for Rating Combination Space-Heating and Water-Heating Appliances	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 124-2007
	Methods of Testing for Efficiency of Space-Conditioning/Water-Heating Appliances That Include a Desuperheater Water Heater	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 137-2013
	Method of Testing Absorption Water-Chilling and Water-Heating Packages	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 182-2020
	Legionellosis: Risk Management for Building Water Systems	ASHRAE	ANSI/ASHRAE 188-2021
	Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code—Section IV: Heating Boilers	ASME	BPVC-2015
	Section VI: Recommended Rules for the Care and Operation of Heating Boilers	ASME	BPVC-2015
	Gas Water Heaters—Vol. I: Storage Water Heaters with Input Ratings of 75,000 Btu per Hour or Less	CSA	ANSI Z21.10.1-2014/CSA 4.1-2014
	Vol. III: Storage Water Heaters with Input Ratings Above 75,000 Btu per Hour, Circulating and Instantaneous	CSA	ANSI Z21.10.3-2014/CSA 4.3-2014
	Oil Burning Stoves and Water Heaters	CSA	B140.3-1962 (R2011)
	Oil-Fired Service Water Heaters and Swimming Pool Heaters	CSA	B140.12-03 (R2013)
	Construction and Test of Electric Storage-Tank Water Heaters	CSA	CAN/CSA-C22.2 No. 110-94 (R2014)
	Performance of Electric Storage Tank Water Heaters for Domestic Hot Water Service	CSA	CSA C191-13
	Energy Efficiency of Electric Storage Tank Water Heaters and Heat Pump Water Heaters	CSA	CSA C745-03 (R2014)
	Water Heaters, Hot Water Supply Boilers, and Heat Recovery Equipment	NSF	ANSI/NSF 5-2012
	Household Electric Storage Tank Water Heaters	UL	ANSI/UL 174-2004
	Oil-Fired Storage Tank Water Heaters	UL	ANSI/UL 732-1995
	Commercial-Industrial Gas Heating Equipment	UL	UL 795-2011
	Electric Booster and Commercial Storage Tank Water Heaters	UL	ANSI/UL 1453-2004
Welding and Brazing	Boiler and Pressure Vessel Code—Section IX: Welding and Brazing Qualifications	ASME	BPVC-2015
	Structural Welding Code—Steel	AWS	AWS D1.1M/D1.1:2010
	Specification for Welding of Austenitic Stainless Steel Tube and Piping Systems in Sanitary Applications	AWS	AWS D18.1:2009

Selected Codes and Standards Published by Various Societies and Associations (*Continued*)

Subject	Title	Publisher	Reference
Wood-Burning Appliances	Threshold Limit Values for Chemical Substances (updated annually)	ACGIH	ACGIH
	Specification for Room Heaters, Pellet Fuel Burning Type	ASTM	ASTM E1509-12
	Guide for Construction of Solid Fuel Burning Masonry Heaters	ASTM	ASTM E1602-03 (2010)e1
	Installation Code for Solid-Fuel-Burning Appliances and Equipment	CSA	CAN/CSA-B365-10
	Solid-Fuel-Fired Central Heating Appliances	CSA	CAN/CSA-B366.1-11
	Chimneys, Fireplaces, Vents, and Solid Fuel-Burning Appliances	NFPA	ANSI/NFPA 211-2013
	Commercial Cooking, Rethermalization and Powered Hot Food Holding and Transport Equipment	NSF	ANSI/NSF 4-2014

ORGANIZATIONS

Abbrev.	Organization	Address	Telephone	http://www.
AABC	Associated Air Balance Council	1518 K Street NW, Suite 503 Washington, D.C. 20005	(202) 737-0202	aabc.com
ABMA	American Boiler Manufacturers Association	8221 Old Courthouse Road, Suite 202 Vienna, VA 22182	(703) 356-7172	abma.com
ACCA	Air Conditioning Contractors of America	2800 S. Shirlington Road, Suite 300 Arlington, VA 22206	(703) 575-4477	acca.org
ACGIH	American Conference of Governmental Industrial Hygienists	1330 Kemper Meadow Drive Cincinnati, OH 45240	(513) 742-2020	acgih.org
ADC	Air Diffusion Council	1901 N. Roselle Road, Suite 800 Schaumburg, IL 60195	(847) 706-6750	flexibleduct.org
AGA	American Gas Association	400 N. Capitol Street NW Washington, D.C. 20001	(202) 824-7000	aga.org
AHAM	Association of Home Appliance Manufacturers	1111 19th Street NW, Suite 402 Washington, D.C. 20036	(202) 872-5955	aham.org
AIHA	American Industrial Hygiene Association	3141 Fairview Park Dr, Suite 777 Falls Church, VA 22042	(703) 207-3561	aiha.org
AMCA	Air Movement and Control Association International	30 West University Drive Arlington Heights, IL 60004	(847) 394-0150	amca.org
ANSI	American National Standards Institute	1899 L Street NW, 11th Floor Washington, D.C. 20036	(202) 293-8020	ansi.org
AHRI	Air-Conditioning, Heating, and Refrigeration Institute	2111 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 500 Arlington, VA 22201	(703) 524-8800	ahrinet.org
ASA	Acoustical Society of America	1305 Walt Whitman Road, Suite 300 Melville, NY 11747-4502	(516) 576-2360	acousticalsociety.org
ASABE	American Society of Agricultural and Biological Engineers	2950 Niles Road St. Joseph, MI 49085	(269) 429-0300	asabe.org
ASHRAE	American Society of Heating, Refrigerating and Air-Conditioning Engineers	1791 Tullie Circle, NE Atlanta, GA 30329	(404) 636-8400	ashrae.org
ASME	American Society of Mechanical Engineers	Two Park Avenue New York, NY 10016-5990	(973) 882-1170	asme.org
ASTM	ASTM International	100 Barr Harbor Drive West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959	(610) 832-9585	astm.org
AWS	American Welding Society	8669 NW 36 Street, #130 Miami, FL 33166	(305) 443-9353	aws.org
AWWA	American Water Works Association	6666 W. Quincy Avenue Denver, CO 80235	(303) 794-7711	awwa.org

ORGANIZATIONS (*Continued*)

Abbrev.	Organization	Address	Telephone	http://www.
BOCA	Building Officials and Code Administrators International	(*see* ICC)		
BSI	British Standards Institution	389 Chiswick High Road London W4 4AL, UK	44 020 8996 9000	bsigroup.com
CAGI	Compressed Air and Gas Institute	1300 Sumner Avenue Cleveland, OH 44115	(216) 241-7333	cagi.org
CSA	Canadian Standards Association International	178 Rexdale Boulevard Toronto, ON M9W 1R3, Canada	(416) 747-4000	csagroup.org
CTI	Cooling Technology Institute	P.O. Box 681807 Houston, TX 77268	(281) 583-4087	cti.org
EJMA	Expansion Joint Manufacturers Association	25 North Broadway Tarrytown, NY 10591	(914) 332-0040	ejma.org
HEI	Heat Exchange Institute	1300 Sumner Avenue Cleveland, OH 44115	(216) 241-7333	heatexchange.org
HI	Hydraulic Institute	6 Campus Drive, First Floor North Parsippany, NJ 07054-4406	(973) 267-9700	pumps.org
HYDI	Hydronics Institute Division of AHRI	(*see* AHRI)		
IAPMO	International Association of Plumbing and Mechanical Officials	4755 E. Philadelphia Street Ontario, CA 91761	(909) 472-4100	iapmo.org
ICBO	International Conference of Building Officials	(*see* ICC)		
ICC	International Code Council	500 New Jersey Ave NW, 6th Floor Washington, D.C. 20001	(888) 422-7233	iccsafe.org
IEEE	Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers	3 Park Avenue, 17th Floor New York, NY 10016-5997	(732) 981-0060	ieee.org
IES	Illuminating Engineering Society	120 Wall Street, Floor 17 New York, NY 10005-4001	(212) 248-5000	ies.org
IFCI	International Fire Code Institute	(*see* ICC)		
IIAR	International Institute of Ammonia Refrigeration	1001 N. Fairfax St, Suite 503 Alexandria, VA 22314	(703) 312-4200	iiar.org
ISA	International Society of Automation	67 T.W. Alexander Drive, P.O. Box 12277 Research Triangle Park, NC 27709	(919) 549-8411	isa.org
ISO	International Organization for Standardization	Chemin de Blandonnet 8, CP 401 1214 Vernier, Geneva, Switzerland	41 22 749 01 11	iso.org
MCAA	Mechanical Contractors Association of America	1385 Piccard Drive Rockville, MD 20850	(301) 869-5800	mcaa.org
MICA	Midwest Insulation Contractors Association	16712 Elm Circle Omaha, NE 68130	(402) 342-3463	micainsulation.org
MSS	Manufacturers Standardization Society of the Valve and Fittings Industry	127 Park Street NE Vienna, VA 22180-4602	(703) 281-6613	mss-hq.com
NAIMA	North American Insulation Manufacturers Association	11 Canal Center Plaza, Suite 103 Alexandria, VA 22314	(703) 684-0084	naima.org
NCPWB	National Certified Pipe Welding Bureau	1385 Piccard Drive Rockville, MD 20850	(301) 869-5800	mcaa.org/ncpwb
NEBB	National Environmental Balancing Bureau	8575 Grovemont Circle Gaithersburg, MD 20877	(301) 977-3698	nebb.org
NEMA	Association of Electrical and Medical Imaging Equipment Manufacturers	1300 North 17th Street, Suite 900 Arlington, VA 22209	(703) 841-3200	nema.org
NFPA	National Fire Protection Association	1 Batterymarch Park Quincy, MA 02169-7471	(617) 770-3000	nfpa.org
NRCC	National Research Council of Canada, Institute for Research in Construction	1200 Montreal Road, Bldg M-58 Ottawa, ON K1A 0R6, Canada	(613) 993-9101	nrc-cnrc.ca
NSF	NSF International	P.O. Box 130140, 789 N. Dixboro Road Ann Arbor, MI 48105	(734) 769-8010	nsf.org
PHCC	Plumbing-Heating-Cooling Contractors Association	180 S. Washington Street, Suite 100 Falls Church, VA 22046	(703) 237-8100	phccweb.org
SAE	SAE International	400 Commonwealth Drive Warrendale, PA 15096	(724) 776-4841	sae.org
SBCCI	Southern Building Code Congress International	(*see* ICC)		

ORGANIZATIONS (*Continued*)

Abbrev.	Organization	Address	Telephone	http://www.
SMACNA	Sheet Metal and Air Conditioning Contractors' National Association	4201 Lafayette Center Drive Chantilly, VA 20151-1219	(703) 803-2980	smacna.org
TEMA	Tubular Exchanger Manufacturers Association	25 North Broadway Tarrytown, NY 10591	(914) 332-0040	tema.org
UL	Underwriters Laboratories	333 Pfingsten Road Northbrook, IL 60062-2096	(847) 272-8800	ul.com
USGBC	U.S. Green Building Council	2101 L Street NW, Suite 500 Washington, D.C. 20037	(202) 742-3792	usgbc.org

ASHRAE HANDBOOK

Additions and Corrections

The following presents additional information and technical errors found between June 15, 2021, and April 3, 2024, in the SI editions of the 2021, 2022, and 2023 *ASHRAE Handbook* volumes. (Occasional typographical errors and nonstandard symbol labels will be corrected in future volumes. The most current list of Handbook additions and corrections is on the ASHRAE web site (www.ashrae.org).

The authors and editor encourage you to notify them if you find other technical errors. Please send corrections to: Handbook Editor, ASHRAE, 180 Technology Parkway, Peachtree Corners, GA, 30092, or e-mail hkennedy@ashrae.org.

2021 Fundamentals

Chapter Updates. Please go to technologyportal.ashrae.org and log in to download updates to Chapters 1, 2, 5, 6, 13, 14, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 23, 24, 31, 34, 35, and 38. ASHRAE members should use their member login; nonmembers should contact ASHRAE customer service at cservice@ashrae.org if they do not have a login.

p. 16.12. Under Equation (31), in the definitions of variables, pressure should be n and the reference should be to Equation (29).

p. 36.22. In the definition of a Petagram (Pg) or gigaton, the numerical value should be 10^{15}.

COMPOSITE INDEX
ASHRAE HANDBOOK SERIES

This index covers the current Handbook series published by ASHRAE. The four volumes in the series are identified as follows:

F = 2021 Fundamentals

R = 2022 Refrigeration

A = 2023 HVAC Applications

S = 2024 HVAC Systems and Equipment

Alphabetization of the index is letter by letter; for example, Heaters precedes Heat exchangers, and Floors precedes Floor slabs.

The page reference for an index entry includes the book letter and the chapter number, which may be followed by a decimal point and the beginning page in the chapter. For example, the page number F30.6 means the information may be found in the 2021 HVAC Fundamentals volume, Chapter 30, beginning on page 6.

Each Handbook volume is revised and updated on a four-year cycle. Because technology and the interests of ASHRAE members change, some topics are not included in the current Handbook series but may be found in the earlier Handbook editions cited in the index.

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Zeolites, R18.10; R41.9; R47.13; S24.5. (*See also* **Molecular sieves**)